# Liturgical and Ecclesiastical Life in Reformation Germany

*An Examination of the German Church Orders from 1521–1620*

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        - 17.14.1 Brandenburg-Ansbach: the priest's oath (1528, 1570, 1573, 1588)
        - 17.14.2 Nürnberg and its neighbours: the 1573 *norma doctrinae* and the refusal of the FC
        - 17.14.3 Regensburg: the CA "in its right sense" (1567), the BoC signed before the consistory (1572/1588)
    - 17.15 Strasbourg and Alsace
        - 17.15.1 The CA in the examination (1549)
        - 17.15.2 "*Stipulata manu*" (1562) and "*corde et manu*" (1577); the FC in the ordination vow (1598)
        - 17.15.3 Colmar: an oath on the CA, and the refusal of the FC (1575, 1578)
    - 17.16 Transylvania
    - 17.17 The laity: confirmation, communion, godparents, citizenship and office
        - 17.17.1 Confirmation: profession, vow and discipline
        - 17.17.2 Admission to communion
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    - 17.18 Table by order
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- Scripture index
- Index of persons
- Glossary

# Introduction

This book describes the worship and the church life of the evangelical churches of the Reformation in Germany and the neighbouring lands, as their own church orders laid them down. A church order (*Kirchenordnung*) is the law that a prince or a city council gave its church. It says who shall preach and what, how the Lord's Supper, baptism and marriage are to be held, which feasts are kept, how ministers are examined and bound, and how the schools and the poor are provided for. The orders read here are those printed in Emil Sehling's edition, *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*: 2,581 texts, dated from 1521 to 1620.

The book is written chiefly for Lutherans who want to know what the first Lutheran churches did: which parts of the Mass they kept and which they dropped, what they sang, how they prayed, preached and kept the church year, and how they ordered their ministries. The orders are left to speak for themselves. Each chapter quotes them in the original, gives a close English translation, and cites every passage to its page in Sehling. Orders of other traditions are used where they show the practice of their time, and they are always marked as such (Conventions).

## The source: Sehling's edition

Emil Sehling, professor of law at Erlangen, began the edition in 1902. By 1913 he had published five volumes at Leipzig, covering Saxony and Thuringia, Brandenburg, Lusatia and Silesia, Prussia, Poland and Pomerania, and the Baltic lands, Mecklenburg, Lübeck, Lauenburg and Hamburg. The Institute for Evangelical Church Law of the Evangelical Church in Germany, at Göttingen, took up the work again in 1955. The Heidelberg Academy of Sciences carried it on, publishing its volumes from 2004, and completed it in 2017. The edition runs to 24 volumes in 30 parts, with two volumes of registers.

Each volume treats a group of territories: principalities and counties, bishoprics, imperial cities and towns, from the North Sea to Transylvania. For each territory an editor's introduction tells the history of its reformation and describes its orders. The orders follow, with their variants and notes. Sehling took "church order" in the widest sense (§1.2.1), so the set holds visitation articles, mandates, consistory and school orders, marriage and poor-law orders, agendas and confessions as well as the great church orders.

Of the 2,581 texts, 1,950 are Lutheran. The rest are Reformed, Moderate Reformed and Philippist, with a few of other traditions (§1.3). Sehling meant to print no orders made for the Augsburg Interim of 1548, and only four are in the set (§1.4). The texts run from Breslau's beggars' order of 1521 to the orders of 1620 for Stade, Limpurg and the Transylvanian Saxons. One later text, a report of 1635 on the consistory of Henneberg, stands outside that range.

## How the book is arranged

Chapter 1 is an inventory of every order in the edition, volume by volume and territory by territory, with its date, its kind, its confessional tradition and whether it belongs to the Interim. Each of the other chapters takes one subject through the whole edition:

- the Mass: its order as a whole (Chapter 2), the preliminaries, confession and exhortation (Chapter 3), the propers (Chapter 4), the collects (Chapter 5), the general prayer (Chapter 6), and the Canon in the German Masses (Chapter 7);
- music: hymns (Chapter 8), and the organ, other instruments and bells (Chapter 9);
- the daily office (Chapter 10), preaching (Chapter 11) and the church year (Chapter 12);
- the occasional and extraordinary rites, from baptism to the Litany (Chapter 13);
- the furnishing of worship: art, architecture, paraments and vestments (Chapter 14);
- the duties of ministers, officers and people (Chapter 15), and the ministries themselves: minor orders, deacons and elders (Chapter 16);
- confessional subscription (Chapter 17).

Most chapters open with a summary of findings and a section on scope, sources and method. They then set out the evidence subject by subject, quoting the orders and translating them. Tables by order follow, and every chapter ends with a concordance of the orders it quotes.

Sections are numbered within their chapter, with the chapter number first: §2.3.2 is section 3.2 of Chapter 2. Every reference to a section is a link, and so is every entry in the Contents. The Scripture index and the Index of persons list the sections where each

passage of Scripture and each person is cited, and the Glossary explains the rarer terms.

## The repository and its methods

The book was made from a digital copy of Sehling's edition and from databases built from it. They are kept, with the programs that built them, in a public repository: https://github.com/sethkasten/sehling-corpus. The chapters sometimes name these files. This section describes them, so that the book can be read without the repository.

### The digital corpus

The corpus is the text of all 24 volumes, in their 30 parts, and of the two register volumes. It was taken from the digitized edition of the Heidelberg Academy of Sciences (digi.hadw-bw.de) and divided into documents. Each document carries:

- Sehling's citation, for example "Sehling 7, I/Bremen Nr. 3";
- its heading, with place and year;
- its range of printed pages;
- its full text, as read by optical character recognition (OCR).

Two limits of the corpus matter for the quotations in this book. Sehling's footnotes, variant readings and editorial brackets stand in the text as printed, mixed with the order itself, because OCR loses the type that tells them apart. They are left out when a passage is quoted (Conventions). And the OCR is not corrected in the corpus, so a quotation can keep a misreading, as the Conventions describe.

Three pairs of half-volumes, 7/1 and 7/2.2, 17/1 and 17/2, and 20/1 and 20/2, were bound as separate books that each number their pages from the beginning. A page number alone is therefore ambiguous in these volumes, and this book always names the half-volume.

### The corpus database (`eko.db`)

`eko.db` is a SQLite database built from the corpus. It holds 2,368 records, one for each document, from the 32 digitized volumes and half-volumes, register volumes included. Each record gives the citation, heading, place, title, year and pages of its document, a link to the facsimile page images, and the full text, which can be searched word by word. The database also holds Sehling's registers of persons, places and subjects, 24,168 entries in all, each linked to the documents it points to. The registers find mentions that a word search would miss, such as older spellings and Latin forms.

The "Doc" numbers in the tables and concordances of this book are the record numbers of `eko.db`. Every quotation is preceded by an invisible note naming the record it was checked against. A record is a unit of the digitized edition, not always one order: one record may hold several short orders, and a long order may run over several records. The database's year and heading for a record are sometimes wrong, so this book names every order from Sehling's running heads instead (see, for example, §8.2.3).

The database is about 120 MB. It is not kept in the repository, but is rebuilt from the corpus by the program `build_database.py`.

### How the chapters were made

Each chapter was made in the same way.

- **Search.** The whole corpus was searched in `eko.db` for the words of the subject in High German, Low German, Dutch and Latin, in their period spellings, and, where useful, through Sehling's registers. Each hit was read in its context.
- **Findings.** What each order prescribes was recorded order by order. Where a thing was looked for and not found, the chapter says so. These negative findings are part of the evidence.
- **Quotations.** Every quotation was checked against the text of its record in `eko.db`, and its page against the edition's page markers (Conventions).
- **Translations** were made from the original, in the idiom of the Authorized Version (Conventions).
- **Traditions.** Each order's confessional tradition and Interim status was fixed once, in the inventory of Chapter 1. The other chapters mark the orders they cite by that inventory (Conventions).

Each chapter's own section on scope, sources and method gives its searches, its sources and its cautions: §1.2, §2.2, §3.2, §4.2, §5.2, §6.2, §7.1.3, §8.2, §9.2, §10.2, §11.2, §12.2, §13.2, §14.2, §15.2, §16.2 and §17.2.

**The hymn database (`hymns.db`)**

`hymns.db`, with its workbook `hymns.xlsx`, holds the **chief-hymn prescriptions**: the places where a church order, a hymnal or a later list assigns a hymn to a particular Sunday, feast or occasion. Chapter 8 treats where and how hymns were sung. The database holds the tables of hymns by day, and Appendix 8.A condenses its "Compare by day" sheet.

The database holds 4,144 prescriptions from 48 witnesses, in two layers that must be kept apart:

- **The church orders.** 466 prescriptions come from the eight orders in Sehling that carry a table of hymns: Pomerania 1569, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Hof 1592, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hohenlohe 1596, Nördlingen 1579 and Heilbronn 1543. All are Lutheran. Weissenfels comes nearest to the later table of one hymn for each Sunday. The word *Hauptlied* does not occur in the corpus. It is later terminology.
- **The hymnals and compilations.** 3,678 prescriptions come from later books and lists:
  - Liliencron's concordance of fifteen hymnals of 1545–1694, Sunday by Sunday;
  - Ludecus's *Ordo cantionum Germanicarum* (1589);
  - Selnecker's own account of the scheme he kept;
  - a modern Hymn of the Day table, which collates the schemes of Selnecker, Carpzov and others with those of modern hymnals;
  - Krusemark's *Hymns ABC* (2018), of which only the hymns of the day are taken.

An order commands what shall be sung. A hymnal records what was sung, sometimes long after.

**Witnesses, not books, are counted.** A witness is counted once, whichever compilation it was read from. Selnecker, for instance, appears in Liliencron, in the Hymn of the Day table and in his own account, and he counts once. One overlap could not be resolved. A column of Krusemark's, taken from Jason Thompson's dissertation, collates Ludecus with twelve other lists of the sixteenth century without saying which list each hymn came from. Where that column and Ludecus agree, Ludecus may be counted twice.

**Titles.** Each hymn is named by its German or Latin incipit as printed, with a literal English rendering. Where the hymn has a received English title, that title is given as well. For 36 hymns with no received title, the title of Matthew Carver's translation is given, from *Walther's Hymnal* (2012) or from his *Hymnoglypt*. 38 hymns have no English title at all. Where a hymn has rival English titles, the choice between them is an editorial judgment, not a fact.

**Assignments.** On five days where no hymn has three old witnesses, the editor of the database assigns one. These are marked "Assigned" and never counted as witnesses.

**The general-prayer workbook and database (`general_prayers.db`)**

`general_prayers.db`, with its workbook `general_prayers.xlsx`, holds the general prayer of the Sunday service (Chapter 6) from every order in Sehling that prints one: 57 orders, dated 1526–1618. The orders give 455 petitions, which fall into 18 families of text and 28 standard categories of intention. Their languages are High German, Low German, Low Dutch and Latin.

Each petition is divided into its rubric (the heading or marginal note), its bid (the words addressed to the people) and its prayer (the words addressed to God). Each part is given in the original and in English.

**How the texts were made.** The original is Sehling's base text with his editorial matter stripped out: sigla, footnote numbers, the variant readings of later editions, page and folio markers, running heads, and words interleaved from the second column by the OCR. The spelling of the print is kept, and obvious OCR slips are corrected. Every rubric, bid and prayer was found again in its record in `eko.db`, with at least nine-tenths of its words. Where one order copies another, the source's English was taken over and corrected wherever the German differs. Each witness is dated as Sehling edits it, not by the year of its record in `eko.db`, which is wrong for several of them.

**The sheets of the workbook.**

- The **Compare** sheet sets the orders side by side, petition by petition.

- The **Prayers** sheet gives every witness's own text.
- The **Archetypes** sheet and four **Critical** sheets collate each family's witnesses into one text for each category, with every variant in square brackets.
- Four **Representative** sheets give one clean text for each family and category. Chapter 6 prints these, family by family.

#### What counts as the general prayer

**Included.** The prayer of intercession for all estates and needs in the chief Sunday service. It is normally after the sermon, from the pulpit. In family L it is in the Mass itself, and in Norden 1528 (Reformed) it stands in the place of the Prone. The following count as part of it:

- an exhortation or preface to it;
- confession and absolution, when the order places them inside the prayer;
- the Our Father, the Creed or the Decalogue, when printed as its close.

Two orders that *prescribe the contents* of the prayer in indirect speech are also included: Magdeburg 1562 and Osnabrück 1543.

**Excluded, deliberately:**

- **Collect banks**, even when they supply the texts for the prayer: Wittenberg 1536, Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Mansfeld 1562, Lippe 1566, Grubenhagen, Hoya, the Prussian collects and Hanau-Lichtenberg's "XII Collecten".
- **The Litany.** It is often the alternative form, and it is a genre of its own.
- **Prayer-day, occasional and emergency prayers**, such as the three prayers of the Wild- and Rhinegraves and the variant in the Nassau *Agende* of 1618.
- **Afternoon, weekday and Vespers forms**, such as the afternoon forms of Henneberg, Strasbourg 1598 and Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed).
- **Orders that only mention the prayer, or give it by reference**: Strasbourg 1577, Hessen 1574 (Philippist), Mecklenburg 1552, Sponheim 1590, Emden 1594 (Reformed; free prayer), Saxony 1539 (Luther's paraphrase, by reference only), and the references to Veit Dietrich's collects.
- **Orders that Sehling prints only as variants of another order.** Kurpfalz 1601 (Reformed) is identical to 1563.

#### Representative texts

The representative texts give one clean text for each family and category, with no brackets. They are built from the same collation as the critical texts, by five rules.

1. **Layout.** A representative cell is filled exactly where the critical cell is.

2. **Majority.** A petition is kept if at least half the family's witnesses to that category have it. Within a petition, a rubric, bid or prayer is kept if at least half its witnesses have it. Word by word:

    - a variant replaces the parent's reading only if at least half the witnesses to that text have it, and more have it than have the parent's reading;
    - an addition is kept if at least half the witnesses to that text have it.

3. **Moved words.** A transposition appears in the collation as an omission at one place and an addition at another. Both are decided by the votes above, so the order that more witnesses have wins. On a tie the parent's order is kept: an addition that exactly half the witnesses have is dropped when its words already stand in the parent close by.

4. **Consistent openings and endings.** Within each family one pattern is applied, taken from the family's own majority:

    - **A (Brenz):** bids end "Bittend also:" (*Pray ye thus:*). Collects end bare, as in Schwäbisch Hall 1526. The mediation formula and Amen that two collects carry are removed.
    - **B1 (Württemberg long form):** bids end "Bittend also:". Collects end "durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen." (*through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.*) wherever they carry a mediation formula or lack a closing Amen.
    - **L (Brandenburg):** collects end "durch deinen son Jesum Christum, amen." (*through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.*), in place of the abbreviation "durch unsern herrn etc.".

The other families' texts are continuous prayers or exhortations whose openings and endings are already consistent.

5. **Divergent texts.** Where no reading has half the witnesses, the parent's reading stands. The parent is the earliest witness: the archetype, or, for an added petition, the earliest witness that has it. The same applies when no petition, or no group of related texts, has half the witnesses.

The English is not voted on separately. Each English variation takes the reading of the witnesses whose reading the original chose at the same place. Where only the English varies, as when two translations render the same words, the parent's English is kept. The original and the English therefore give the same text. Sehling's editorial brackets are removed.

#### What the comparison shows

- **Civil authority is the one universal intention.** It appears in all 57 orders, and in some it is prayed for twice. The Lüneburg family (J) has one petition for the Emperor and all magistrates, and another for the princess of the land and the young lordship.
- **The Church, then the magistrates, is the normal Lutheran sequence.** It comes from Brenz 1526 through Württemberg 1553, and so reaches roughly half the orders. The typical series is: exhortation > the Church > magistrates > the afflicted > peace > enemies > women with child > fruits of the earth > the Our Father. The Reformed Heidelberg prayer begins elsewhere: confession > thanksgiving > the Word > magistrates > all men > the persecuted > the afflicted. Its petition for **all men** (1 Tim. 2) is a Reformed and Upper German feature. It occurs only in Heidelberg (R1, with the Lutheran Schaumburg 1614, which borrows the Heidelberg prayer), in Calvin (R3) and in Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed).
- **The Word and its fruit is named in almost every family except the Brenz and Württemberg line.** There it is folded into the petition for the Church, and only two witnesses of that line add it: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 (long form) and Magdeburg 1562. It opens the prayer in the Nürnberg exhortation (D), in Bugenhagen and Osnabrück (H), in the Lower Saxon *notel* (J) and in Heidelberg (R1, R2; Reformed).
- **Women with child are prayed for almost everywhere.** They are named in 42 of the 57 orders: in a petition of their own in the Brenz and Württemberg long forms, and within the petition for the afflicted in the short form and most other families. They are absent from the Mass intercessions (L); from Calvin, à Lasco and the Heidelberg paraphrase (all Reformed); from Veit Dietrich's exhortation (Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556); and from Osnabrück, Magdeburg, Leipzig, Hessen (Moderate Reformed), Worms and Norden (Reformed).
- **Brandenburg 1540 and its followers (family L) put the intercessions in the Mass, under the Sanctus.** These are collects for the ministers, the magistrates and peace, standing where the Roman Canon had its prayers of intercession (Sehling's note on Pfalz-Neuburg 1543). They are the closest evangelical survival of the Canon's intercessions in the corpus.
- **The Württemberg short form is the most copied prayer in the corpus.** Its 17 witnesses run from 1553 to 1618 and reach Electoral Saxony (1580), Magdeburg, Strasbourg and the Wetterau counts. Their local changes include the name of the ruling house, heretics among the enemies, the fallen-away and daily bread.

## Conventions

These conventions hold throughout the book.

### Citations and references

- **Sehling.** Citations are in the form "Sehling volume, page", for example "(Sehling 8, p. 245)". The half-volumes of the edition are written 6/1, 6/2, 7/1, 7/2.1, 7/2.2, 17/1, 17/2, 19/1, 19/2, 20/1 and 20/2, following the digitized volumes. Where a passage comes from the editor's introduction, notes or apparatus rather than from the text of an order, this is said.
- **Orders** are named by place, title and date as Sehling's running heads give them, for example "**Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566**". These names sometimes differ from the headings of the records in `eko.db` (Introduction; see, for example, §8.2.3).
- **Doc** in the tables and concordances is the number of the record in `eko.db` that holds the page cited (Introduction). Each quotation is preceded by a note, invisible in print, that names the record it was checked against.
- **Sections** are numbered within their chapter, with the chapter number first: §2.3.2 is section 3.2 of Chapter 2. Appendices are lettered: Appendix 4.A has the sections 4.A.1, 4.A.2 and so on. In Chapter 6 the petitions of each family keep the

family's own numbering (A.1, B1.13) under the numbered family sections. Every reference to a section or a chapter is a link.

- **Concordances.** Each chapter ends with a concordance of the orders it quotes or cites. Its "§" or "Quoted in §" column gives the sections where each order is cited, and each number is a link. In Chapters 4 and 5, "A" in that column means the chapter's appendix.

## Quotations

- Every quotation is the text of Sehling or his successors as it stands in `eko.db`, the database built from the digitized edition (Introduction). A block quotation is followed by its English translation.
- **Left out:** footnote numbers, sigla, folio markers, the editor's dates in square brackets (such as "[25. Dez.]"), "[Noten]" marks and the like, and apparatus interleaved by the OCR.
- **Kept:** the editor's own supplied words and letters in square brackets (as in *Nemen[t]*), "[!]", "[sic]" and his other signs, and the bracketed alternatives that some orders print themselves. Words supplied in this book to complete a sentence cut by a page break or a footnote are also in square brackets.
- **Spelling and punctuation** are as printed, including plain OCR errors such as "heilaut" for "heiland", "hemehck" for "hemelick", "Gorpus" for "Corpus" or "heiser" for "keiser". In some chapters a few plain OCR errors are corrected, as "Mariae" for the printed "Marfae". In Chapter 7 the notes say where.
- **Omissions.** "[…]" marks an omission. In Chapter 7 it also stands for a hymn or lesson that the order prints in full, or for text given in another section.
- **Checking.** Every quotation has been checked against the database text, allowing for OCR noise: at least 90 per cent of its words must be found there in order. Its page has been checked against the edition's page markers.
- **The Canon texts (Chapter 7)** are Sehling's base text, with his footnote numbers, sigla, variant apparatus and page and folio markers removed. Line-break hyphens are joined. A cross (✠) marks where the print has a sign of the cross over the elements, and rubrics are in italics. The Roman comparison texts are the standard texts of the late-medieval and Tridentine *Ordo Missae*. The diocesan missals of the 1520s–40s differ in small details. Where a German text follows a wording that the Tridentine missal does not have, this is noted, but the wording is not attributed to a particular missal.
- **The general-prayer texts (Chapter 6)** are Sehling's text with his apparatus removed. "N." stands where the order leaves a name to be filled in, and "etc." where it gives only the opening of a well-known text, such as the Our Father or the Creed. Each petition is given as its **rubric** (a heading or direction printed with it), its **bid** (the words addressed to the people, "Let us pray for …") and its **prayer** (the words addressed to God). The **witnesses** are the orders that carry a family's text, named by place and year as in the workbook (Introduction).
- **Texts from outside Sehling.** Where a German collect renders a prayer of the Missal (Chapter 5), the Latin is given from the Roman Missal of the period. Where Sehling's editors identify the source, this is said, and where the identification is this book's own, that is said too. The English of the Common Service and the later American Lutheran books, given in §3.4.5 for comparison, is not set as a quotation and has not been checked against the corpus.

## Translations

- The English is formal-equivalence, in the idiom of the Authorized Version (thee and thou, -eth). Word order and clause structure are kept where English allows, and nothing is smoothed away. Words the translation supplies are in square brackets.
- Liturgical names keep their customary Latin or English forms: Kyrie, Gloria, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus, *Benedicamus*, Matins, Lauds, Prime, Vespers, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum*, the Our Father. Stock liturgical phrases are given in their familiar English: *Vere dignum et iustum est* is "It is very meet and right", and *Oremus* and "Last uns bitten" are "Let us pray". Scripture quoted in a prayer is given in the wording of the Authorized Version where the German follows the same text.
- Book titles are given in their usual English form ("the Augsburg Confession", "the Smalcald Articles"). *Corpus doctrinae* and *norma doctrinae* are left in Latin.
- Hymn incipits are translated literally and put in quotation marks, so that the reader can see what the words say. They are not given under the titles of the English hymnals. Thus "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" is "Now pray we the Holy Ghost", and "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" is "Keep us, Lord, by thy word". In the running text the German incipit is used.
- Stock terms are rendered the same way throughout:

| Original | English |
|---|---|
| *Absolution* | absolution |
| *Alba* | alb |
| *Amt*, *ampt* | the office (the communion service) |
| *Amtmann* | officer |
| *Aposteltage* | apostles' days |
| *aufbieten*, *proclamieren* | proclaim (the banns) |
| *Bann* | ban |
| *Beicht* | confession |
| *Beiern* | chime (striking the hanging bell with its clapper, not swinging it) |
| *Bekenntnis* | confession |
| *bestätigen*, *bestetigen* | confirm |
| *Bild*, *imago* | image |
| *Borkirche* | gallery |
| *Chorkappe*, *Chormantel*, *cappa* | cope |
| *Chorrock*, *Chorhemd*, *superpellicium* | surplice |
| *copulieren*, *einsegnen* | marry, bless |
| *Diacon*, *diaken* | deacon |
| *Diener des Worts* | minister of the word |
| *einsetzen* | set in office |
| *Eltesten*, *seniores* | elders |
| *Fasten*, *vasten* | Lent, when it names the season; fasting otherwise |
| *Feiertag*, *vyrdach* | holy day |
| *feiern*, *vyren* | keep holy (a day) |
| *Fest* | feast |
| *figurieren*, *in mensuris* | figured music, measured music |
| *fürnembste Feste* | chiefest feasts |
| *geloben* | vow |
| *Gemälde*, *pictura* | painting |
| *gemeine Feste* | common feasts |
| *Gesetz*, *Vers*, *Versch* | stanza, verse |
| *Gesinde* | servants |
| *Glöcklein*, *Schelle*, *campanula* | little bell, handbell |
| *Hauptfeste* | chief feasts |
| *Hausvater* | householder |

| Original | English |
|---|---|
| *Historie* | history |
| *hohe Feste* | high feasts |
| *Kirchendiener* | minister of the church |
| *Kirchenpfleger* | churchwarden |
| *Küster*, *Köster*, *Kirchner*, *Custos*, *Mesner*, *Opfermann*, *opperman* | sexton (sometimes "custos") |
| *Leise* | kept as *Leise* |
| *Leuten* | ring |
| *Lied*, *Gesang*, *Lobgesang* | song, song of praise |
| *Meßgewand*, *Casel*, *casula* | Mass vestment, chasuble |
| *mit handgebender Treue* | with fealty given by the hand |
| *ordinieren* | ordain |
| *Orgel schlagen*, *orgeln*, *up der orgel spelen* | play [on] the organ |
| *Ornat*, *ornatus* | ornaments |
| *Pfarrer*, *Pfarrherr* | pastor |
| *Predigtstuhl*, *Kanzel* | pulpit |
| *Psalm*, *deutscher Psalm* | psalm, German psalm (any metrical hymn, not only a psalm paraphrase) |
| *Puls* | pulse (a single spell of ringing) |
| *Quatember*, *Fronfasten* | the Ember days |
| *Sakramentshäuslein* | sacrament house |
| *Schulmeister* | schoolmaster |
| *schwören* | swear |
| *Stuhl* (in a church) | pew |
| *Superattendent*, *Superintendent* | superintendent |
| *Tafel* | panel (the painted altarpiece) |
| *Taufe* | baptism |
| *Taufstein* | font |
| *Tüchlein* | little cloth |
| *unterschreiben*, *subscribieren* | subscribe |
| *Verhör*, *examen* | examination |
| *verlegen* | remove, lay over |
| *Vermanung* | exhortation |
| *Verstand* | sense, understanding |
| *Vierzeiten*, *veer tide* | the four times |

| Original | English |
|---|---|
| *weihen* | hallow |
| *Zeichen* | sign |

### Traditions and the Interim

Most of the orders cited are Lutheran, and they are not marked. Every order of another tradition is marked where it is cited, by its name in brackets after the order, as "Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed)" or "Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed)". Orders made under or for the Augsburg Interim of 1548 are marked as Interim orders. The traditions and the Interim orders are those of the inventory in Chapter 1 (§1.3, §1.4):

- **Reformed**: the Swiss, Calvinist and Heidelberg churches, among them the German territories that turned Reformed after 1560 and the French and Dutch stranger churches;
- **Moderate Reformed**: the Bucerian and related orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim, Philip of Hesse's church to 1566, Hermann von Wied's Cologne order, Rothmann's Münster, East Frisia under John a Lasco, and Colmar after 1578;
- **Philippist**: the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* and refused the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568–1598, Bremen 1556–1575, Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 and Anhalt 1590–1594;
- **Anglican**: the English exile congregation at Frankfurt;
- **Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite): the Unity of the Brethren in Greater Poland;
- **Sandomierz consensus**: the Polish synods at which Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren met together;
- **Roman Catholic humanist**: the Erasmian orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg, which reform the old church without leaving it;
- **Roman Catholic**: the Bishop of Münster's edict of 1534 against the Anabaptists;
- **Radical Reformation**: Thomas Müntzer's Allstedt orders;
- **Anabaptist**: the Münster council's mandate of January 1534, which tolerated the Anabaptists;
- **Reformed–Lutheran treaty**: the East Frisian settlements of 1595 and 1599;
- **Multi-confessional**: the decrees of the Transylvanian diets, which received the Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian religions side by side. The Transylvanian Saxons' own orders, chapters and synods are Lutheran.

**The mark follows the order cited, not the territory**, since a territory could change its tradition:

- Strasbourg is Moderate Reformed until the Interim of 1548 and Lutheran after it. Its German Masses of 1524–1525 are Moderate Reformed, and Marbach's order of 1553 is Lutheran.
- Kurpfalz is Lutheran in 1546 and 1556 and under Ludwig VI (1576–1583), and Reformed in 1563–1576 and from 1583. Johann Casimir's Pfalz-Lautern stayed Reformed under Ludwig VI.
- Hesse is Moderate Reformed under Philip (to 1566) and Philippist under his sons. After the division, Hessen-Kassel turned Reformed (1605) and Hessen-Darmstadt stayed Lutheran.
- Bremen is Philippist from 1556 to 1575 and Reformed from 1582.
- Nassau-Dillenburg is Lutheran to 1570, Philippist in 1575 and Reformed from 1581.
- Anhalt is Philippist in 1590–1594 and Reformed from 1596.
- Pfalz-Zweibrücken is Lutheran until 1588, and Pfalz-Simmern until it fell to the Electoral Palatinate in 1598.

Where an order could be counted either Moderate Reformed or Philippist, it is counted Moderate Reformed. Some further distinctions:

- "Philippist" also names a party within the Lutheran churches, as in Electoral Saxony before 1574. An order is marked " (Philippist)" only where the inventory counts it so.
- The family names of the Mass in Chapter 2 (§2.4) are names of liturgical shape. "Upper German" there means the south-western Lutheran service of Württemberg and its copies, not the Moderate Reformed Upper German Reformation of Bucer's circle.
- The orders that took over Müntzer's German propers (Erfurt 1525, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Lippe 1571) are Lutheran. Only Müntzer's own Allstedt orders are marked.

- Some Lutheran orders took the Reformed line on images, vestments or vessels: Lichtenberg 1579, Sponheim 1590/91, the Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 and Nassau-Weilburg 1617. They are Lutheran orders, and the text says where they agree with the Reformed.
- Swiss sources outside the corpus (Zürich 1525, Basel 1526, Geneva) are Reformed.

## Abbreviations

- **Confessional writings** (Chapter 17 and elsewhere): CA = the Augsburg Confession (1530); CA *variata* = Melanchthon's altered edition of 1540; Apol = the Apology of the Augsburg Confession; SA = the Smalcald Articles; SC and LC = Luther's Small and Large Catechisms; FC = the Formula of Concord (1577); BoC = the Book of Concord (1580); *CPhil* = the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560); KO = *Kirchenordnung*, church order.
- **The parts of the Mass**, in the tables of Chapter 2: Intr. (the introit, or the hymn in its place), Ky. (Kyrie), Gl. (Gloria), Coll. (collect), Ep. (epistle), Grad. (gradual, alleluia, sequence, or the hymn after the epistle), Gosp. (gospel), Cr. (creed), Serm. (sermon), Exh. (exhortation to the communicants), Pref. (Preface), San. (Sanctus), PN (Lord's Prayer), Verba (Words of Institution), Agn. (Agnus Dei), Comm. (distribution), Thanks. (postcommunion collect or thanksgiving), Bl. (blessing). Brackets mark a part that the order allows but does not require, and "→" separates the parts.
- **Traditions**, in the tables of Chapter 1: L = Lutheran; R = Reformed; MR = Moderate Reformed (Bucerian and Upper German); PH = Philippist; A = Anglican; H = Hussite (Unity of the Bohemian Brethren); C = Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren together); R/L = Reformed and Lutheran (treaty between the two); RCH = Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian reform); RC = Roman Catholic; RAD = Radical Reformation (Müntzer); ANA = Anabaptist (civic toleration of the Anabaptists); T = multi-confessional diet decree (Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian received side by side).

## The inventory tables of Chapter 1

- **No.** is the number Sehling, or the later editor, gives the text within its territory. Volumes 1–5 number their registers in their own way, and their numbers are given as they stand.
- **Order** is the title as Sehling's tables of contents give it. For volumes 1–5 the titles come from the chronological register at the end of each volume. Long titles are shortened, and "…" marks the cut. Spelling is as printed, including OCR errors.
- **Date** is the year in the title or in the register. A few undated texts are dated from the text or from the editor's introduction or notes, as the notes column says. "n.d." means no single year is known.
- **Sehling** gives the volume and the page where the text begins. For volume 14 it is sometimes the introduction page where Sehling only describes the order.
- **Doc** is the record in `eko.db` that holds that page (Introduction).
- **Kind** is assigned from the words of the title (§1.2.4).
- **Trad.** gives the tradition, in the codes listed under Abbreviations.
- **Interim / notes** marks the Interim orders and texts tied to the Interim (§1.4), and adds notes such as the reigning prince.

# Chapter 1. The Church Orders: An Inventory by Tradition

This chapter lists every order that Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* prints, volume by volume and territory by territory: 2,581 texts in 24 volumes (30 parts). For each order it gives:

- its number in Sehling, its title, and its date;
- the page in Sehling and the `eko.db` document that holds the text;
- what kind of order it is (church order, agenda, visitation order, mandate, and so on);
- the confessional tradition it belongs to: Lutheran, Reformed, Moderate Reformed (Bucer's circle and the Upper German cities), Philippist, Anglican, Hussite, and a few others;
- whether it is an Interim order, or otherwise tied to the Augsburg Interim of 1548.

**Confessional traditions and Interim orders**

Sehling's title calls these the *evangelical* church orders, and most of them are Lutheran: 1,950 of the 2,581 texts. The rest belong to other traditions:

- **Reformed** (340): the Swiss, Calvinist and Heidelberg churches, among them the German territories that turned Reformed after 1560 and the French and Dutch stranger churches;
- **Moderate Reformed** (198): the Bucerian and related orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim, Philip of Hesse's church to 1566, Hermann von Wied's Cologne order, Rothmann's Münster, East Frisia under John a Lasco, and Colmar after 1578;
- **Philippist** (33): the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* and refused the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568-1598, Bremen 1556-1575, Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 and Anhalt 1590-1594;
- a few others: Anglican (the English exile congregation at Frankfurt), the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), the Sandomierz consensus of Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren in Poland, the Roman Catholic humanist orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg, Thomas Müntzer's orders (Radical Reformation), one Roman Catholic and one Anabaptist-toleration text from Münster, two Reformed-Lutheran treaties in East Frisia, and the multi-confessional Transylvanian diet decrees.

A territory's tradition can change from one order to the next: Kurpfalz is Lutheran in 1556 and Reformed in 1563, and Strasbourg Moderate Reformed before the Interim of 1548 and Lutheran after it. This chapter gives the tradition of every order (§1.3 defines them). Where an order could be counted either Moderate Reformed or Philippist, it is counted Moderate Reformed. The chapter also lists the few Interim orders and the texts tied to the Augsburg Interim (§1.4).

The other chapters mark every order of another tradition, and every Interim order, where they cite it (Conventions).

**Layout**

- §1.1 summarizes the findings.
- §1.2 sets out the scope, the method and the cautions.
- §1.3 defines the traditions and says where each is found.
- §1.4 lists the Interim orders and the other texts tied to the Interim.
- §1.5 is a table of the territories at a glance.
- §§1.6-1.35 are the inventory itself, one section per volume. Each territory has a short note on its confessional history, followed by a table of its orders.

The columns of the inventory tables and the codes for the traditions are explained in the Conventions.

## 1.1 Summary of findings

**1. The set holds 2,581 orders.** Sehling took "church order" in the widest sense (§1.2.1). The set therefore includes far more than the great church orders and agendas:

| Kind | Texts |
|---|---|
| Church order | 333 |

| Kind | Texts |
|---|---|
| Agenda / liturgy | 271 |
| Visitation | 346 |
| Mandate / decree | 436 |
| Consistory / synod / government | 265 |
| Discipline / police | 178 |
| Marriage | 90 |
| Poor relief | 82 |
| School / university | 65 |
| Catechism / instruction | 44 |
| Monastery / chapter | 46 |
| Appointment / oath | 59 |
| Treaty / agreement | 77 |
| Articles / statutes | 45 |
| Local order | 59 |
| Confession / doctrine | 31 |
| Property / endowment | 6 |
| Other | 148 |

The full church orders (**333**) and the agendas and other liturgical orders (**271**) together make up about a quarter of the set. Many of the rest are visitation orders, mandates, consistory and synod orders, and orders on marriage, discipline, schools and the poor.

**2. Most of the orders are Lutheran.** By tradition:

| Tradition | Code | Texts |
|---|---|---|
| Lutheran | L | 1950 |
| Reformed | R | 340 |
| Moderate Reformed (Bucerian and Upper German) | MR | 198 |
| Philippist | PH | 33 |
| Anglican | A | 1 |
| Hussite (Unity of the Bohemian Brethren) | H | 3 |
| Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren together) | C | 6 |
| Reformed and Lutheran (treaty between the two) | R/L | 2 |
| Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian reform) | RCH | 18 |
| Roman Catholic | RC | 1 |
| Radical Reformation (Müntzer) | RAD | 3 |
| Anabaptist (civic toleration of the Anabaptists) | ANA | 1 |
| Multi-confessional diet decree (Catholic, Lutheran, Reformed and Unitarian received side by side) | T | 25 |

- **Lutheran** (1,950): Saxony, Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, the Baltic, Mecklenburg, the Hanse towns, Lower Saxony, Franconia, Württemberg, Hohenlohe and most of the imperial cities after 1552.
- **Reformed** (340): above all the Electoral Palatinate (from 1561/63) and the "Second Reformation" counties of the Wetterau and the Rhine (Nassau-Dillenburg, Hanau-Münzenberg, Ysenburg, Solms-Braunfels, Sayn, Wied, Wittgenstein, Moers, Bentheim-Tecklenburg), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1588), Pfalz-Simmern (1598, under the Electoral Palatinate), Hessen-Kassel (1600/1605), Lippe (1600), Anhalt (1596), Bremen (from 1580), Emden and the East Frisian Reformed congregations, the London Dutch church, Mülhausen (Mulhouse), and the French refugee churches of Frankfurt, Wetzlar and the Lebertal.
- **Moderate Reformed** (198): Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German cities before the Interim (Konstanz, Ulm, Esslingen, Augsburg, Memmingen, Lindau, Isny, Biberach, Gengenbach, Landau, Worms, early Frankfurt); Philip's Hesse to 1566; Hermann von Wied's Cologne Reformation (1543-1546); Rothmann's Münster (1532/33); East Frisia under Countess Anna; Colmar after 1578, whose pastors came from Basel.
- **Philippist** (33): the joint Hessian synods and orders of 1568-1582 and the Hessian orders that followed them to 1598; Bremen (1556-1575); Nassau-Dillenburg (1575); Anhalt (1590-1594).
- **Anglican** (1): the order of the English exile congregation at Frankfurt, the "Old Discipline" and "New Discipline" of 1557 (§1.3.4).
- **Hussite** (3): the order of the Unity of the Bohemian Brethren (synod of Zerawitz, 1616) and the privileges for the Brethren's congregations at Ostroróg (1569) and Lissa (1580), in Greater Poland (§1.3.5). Six more Polish texts belong to the **Sandomierz consensus** of 1570, in which Lutherans, Reformed and Brethren joined.
- **Others**, each labelled with its own affiliation (§1.3.6):
  - **Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian)** (18): the church orders of Jülich-Cleves-Berg;
  - **Roman Catholic** (1): the Bishop of Münster's edict against the Anabaptists (1534);
  - **Radical Reformation** (3): Thomas Müntzer's Allstedt orders;
  - **Anabaptist** (1): the Münster council's mandate of January 1534 that let each keep his faith and so recognized the Anabaptists;
  - **Multi-confessional** (25): the decrees of the Transylvanian diets;
  - **Reformed and Lutheran** (2): two East Frisian treaties between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.
- **Not in the set**: no order of the Waldensians, Lollards, Utraquists, Schwenckfelders, Hutterites, Mennonites or Antitrinitarians. Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, Davidjorists, Mennonites and "Sakramentierer" appear only as the targets of some thirty mandates, which are coded by the authority that issued them.

**3. Almost no Interim orders.** Sehling deliberately left out the orders made under the Augsburg Interim of 1548 (§1.2.2). Only four Interim orders proper are in the set (§1.4):

- the Brandenburg-Ansbach "Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung" (the "Auctuarium") of 1548, printed "because of its special importance";
- the East Frisian Interim order of 16 July 1549, printed in the editor's introduction;
- the Württemberg Interim mandate of 1548;
- the Biberach council's mandate after accepting the Interim (1548).

16 further texts are tied to the Interim in other ways: issued under it, about it, or ending it (§1.4).

**4. Tradition followed the ruler, and changed with him.** Many territories changed tradition within the century, and their orders change with them:

- **Electoral Palatinate**: Lutheran → Reformed (1561/63) → Lutheran (1577) → Reformed (1583).
- **Upper Palatinate**: Lutheran → Reformed (1559) → Lutheran (1577) → Reformed (1583).
- **Nassau-Dillenburg**: Lutheran → Philippist (1573) → Reformed (1578).
- **Bremen**: Lutheran → Philippist (1562) → Reformed (1580).
- **Hanau-Münzenberg** (1595), **Sayn** (1605), **Lippe** (1600), **Pfalz-Zweibrücken** (1588), **Wittgenstein** (about 1574), **Moers** (1578) and **Bentheim-Tecklenburg** (1580s): Lutheran → Reformed.
- **Ysenburg**: Ronneburg-Kelsterbach was Reformed 1584-1597, then Lutheran again; Birstein became Reformed in 1596.
- **The Upper German cities**: Upper German before the Interim, Lutheran afterwards.

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## 1.2 Scope, sources and cautions

#### 1.2.1 What Sehling counted as a church order

Sehling took the term in its widest sense, to cover every ordinance that regulated church affairs. **Sehling, preface to vol. 1, 1902** (Sehling 1, p. VIII):

> Wir fassen daher für unsere Sammlung den Begriff „Kirchen-Ordnung“im weitesten Sinne des Wortes und verstehen darunter alle zur Regelung der kirchlichen Verhältnisse bestimmten Verfügungen (mit Ausnahme natürlich der nur vorübergehenden Einzelzwecken dienenden Anordnungen).

We therefore take the term "church order" for our collection in the widest sense of the word, and understand by it all ordinances made for the regulation of church affairs (excepting, of course, those orders that served merely passing and particular ends).

#### 1.2.2 What he left out: half measures and the Interim

Sehling also excluded orders that were never in force, and the "half measures" of wavering rulers. **Sehling, preface to vol. 1, 1902** (Sehling 1, p. XV):

> Ferner werden nur die wahrhaft evangelischen Kirchen-Ordnungen gebracht werden. Ausgenommen sind die halben Massregeln, wie sie schwankende Obrigkeiten zur Beschwichtigung der Gemüther, oder wohl auch im Bestreben, Reformen einzuführen, getroffen haben, ohne dass es jedoch eigentlich evangelische Ordnungen geworden wären. Insonderheit gedenke ich nicht abzudrucken die Interims-Kirchen-Ordnungen.

Furthermore, only the truly evangelical church orders will be given. Excepted are the half measures that wavering authorities made to calm men's minds, or perhaps in an effort to bring in reforms, without their ever becoming truly evangelical orders. In particular I do not intend to print the Interim church orders.

He held to this for Saxony, where the great Interim agenda of 1549 is only described. **Sehling, introduction to Albertine Saxony** (Sehling 1, p. 102):

> Die Zeit des Interims wird in unserer Sammlung nur gestreift, und es wird daher auch die in diese Zeit fallende grosse Ordnung, die, ein Produkt der Noth und der Nachgiebigkeit, nicht als eine rein evangelische Ordnung bezeichnet werden kann, hier nicht weiter behandelt.

The period of the Interim is only touched on in our collection, and so the great order that falls in that period is not treated further here either: a product of necessity and of yielding, it cannot be called a purely evangelical order.

His successors kept the rule, with one deliberate exception. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, editor's introduction** (Sehling 11, p. 291):

> Obwohl im allgemeinen Interimsordnungen in diese Ausgabe nicht aufgenommen werden sollen, wird diese ihrer besonderen Bedeutung wegen doch als Nr. IV 4 zum Abdruck gebracht.

Although Interim orders are in general not to be taken into this edition, this one is nevertheless printed as no. IV 4 because of its special importance.

Later volumes also print Reformed, Erasmian and multi-confessional orders: the Reformed Palatinate and the Wetterau counties, the Jülich orders, the Transylvanian diets. The inventory follows the volumes as they stand.

#### 1.2.3 How the list was made

- **The list of texts.** It is taken from each volume's own table of contents (volumes 6-24) or chronological register (volumes 1-5).
  - Where the scanned contents page is unusable, the titles were read from the running heads of the texts. This applies to Oldenburg and Jever in vol. 7/2.1.
  - The registers of volumes 1-5 list orders printed "ganz oder theilweise", in whole or in part. They therefore include some orders printed only in extract within an introduction.

    - Volume 14 (Kurpfalz) lists, among its texts, some orders that Sehling only describes in his introduction. These are marked "described in the introduction only".
    - Introductions, registers and editorial chapters are left out.
- **Tradition.** It is assigned by territory and date, following the editors' introductions. Each territory's note in §§1.6-1.35 gives its confessional history and the dates of change; each order takes the tradition of its territory at its date. Where an order belongs to a group with another tradition, it is marked individually. Examples:
    - a refugee congregation in a Lutheran city;
    - Hessen-Darmstadt orders within divided Hesse;
    - Solms-Braunfels within Solms;
    - the Lemgo recess of 1617, which guaranteed the town's Lutheran confession within Reformed Lippe.
- **Interim.** Texts are marked from their titles and from the editors' introductions (§1.4).

#### 1.2.4 Kinds

The **Kind** column sorts the orders by the main word of the title. The kinds are:

- *Church order*: Kirchenordnung, Agenda das ist Kirchenordnung, Reformation, ordinatio;
- *Agenda / liturgy*: Agende, Messe, Gottesdienst, Taufe, Trauung, Abendmahl, Gesang, Gebet, Litanei, Vesper, Beichte, Busse, Ordination;
- *Visitation*: visitation orders and recesses, general articles;
- *Consistory / synod / government*: consistory, synod, church council, superintendent, classis, presbytery, ministerium, church officers;
- *Marriage*, *School / university*, *Poor relief*, *Monastery / chapter*, *Appointment / oath*, *Confession / doctrine*, *Catechism / instruction*, *Treaty / agreement*, *Property / endowment*;
- *Articles / statutes*: articles, instructions, leges, statutes;
- *Discipline / police*: Zucht, Polizei, Sonntag, Feiertag, Täufer, Landordnung;
- *Mandate / decree*: Mandat, Edikt, Befehl, Ausschreiben, Verordnung;
- *Local order*: an "Ordnung für" a town or village without further description;
- *Other*.

Large church orders contain agendas, catechisms and much else besides. The Kind column gives only the leading character of the title. Search the text in `eko.db` for the parts of a large order.

#### 1.2.5 Cautions

- **Coding by territory.** The tradition codes follow the territory and its ruler. They do not judge each text's theology; a Lutheran territory's marriage or poor-law order is coded L.

- **Moderate Reformed and Philippist.** The orders that stood between the Lutheran and the Reformed are divided into two groups (§1.3.3):

    - **Moderate Reformed**: Bucer's Strasbourg and the Upper German Zwinglian-Bucerian cities; Philip of Hesse's church, which stood within the Wittenberg Concord but bore Bucer's stamp; Hermann von Wied's Cologne order; and the other orders of Bucer's sphere;
    - **Philippist**: the churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* and would not accept the Formula of Concord: the joint Hessian synods, Bremen, Nassau-Dillenburg and Anhalt, each on its way to the Reformed.

    Where an order could be placed in either group, it is counted as Moderate Reformed. Use the territory notes for the finer distinctions.

- **Early orders** (1522-1530) come before the confessional lines were fixed. They are coded by what the territory became; Müntzer's orders are coded as radical.

- **Pages and dates.** Some come from OCR of contents pages and registers. Where a register's page was plainly wrong, it was checked against the text; a few may still be out by a page or two.

- **Doc** is the `eko.db` document holding the start page. One database record may hold several orders, and one order may run over several records.

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## 1.3 The traditions

### 1.3.1 Lutheran (L)

Orders of territories and cities that held to the Augsburg Confession in its Lutheran reading, from the Wittenberg orders of the 1520s to the Formula of Concord and after. 1,950 texts. Volumes 3, 5, 6/1, 6/2, 7/2.1, 11, 15, 16 and 23 are wholly Lutheran, and volume 1 is too, save Müntzer's three orders. Lutheran orders are a minority only in volumes 8 (Hesse, coded Moderate Reformed and Philippist), 10 (Nassau, Hanau, Ysenburg), 14 and 19/2 (Kurpfalz), 20/1 (Strasbourg) and 20/2 (Alsace).

### 1.3.2 Reformed (R)

Orders of churches that took the Reformed (Swiss, Calvinist or Heidelberg) confession. Most belong to the "Second Reformation" of German territories that turned from Lutheran to Reformed after 1560. The rest are refugee and stranger churches (French, Dutch, Walloon) and the Swiss-allied city of Mülhausen.

- Principality of Anhalt (Sehling 2, §1.7): 3 texts, 1596-1599.
- Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns (Sehling 4, §1.9): 3 texts, 1560-1561.
- East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London) (Sehling 7/1, §1.13): 15 texts, 1528-1606.
- City of Bremen (Sehling 7/2.2, §1.15): 13 texts, 1582-1616.
- Divided Hesse (1582-1618) (Sehling 9, §1.17): 11 texts, 1600-1618.
- County of Solms (Sehling 9, §1.17): 7 texts, 1582-1616.
- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 2 texts, 1554-1585.
- Imperial city of Wetzlar (Sehling 9, §1.17): 2 texts, 1586-1596.
- Nassau-Dillenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 14 texts, 1581-1618.
- County of Hanau-Münzenberg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 24 texts, 1596-1614.
- County of Ysenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 12 texts, 1580-1614.
- Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate) (Sehling 13, §1.21): 13 texts, 1566-1615.
- Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz) (Sehling 14, §1.22): 67 texts, 1561-1615.
- Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Sehling 18, §1.27): 13 texts, 1588-1617.
- County of Sayn (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 3 texts, 1606-1619.
- County of Wied (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 8 texts, 1564-1619.
- Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14) (Sehling 19/2, §1.29): 65 texts, 1577-1610.
- Principality of Pfalz-Simmern (Sehling 19/2, §1.29): 2 texts, 1598.
- Lordship of Rappoltstein (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 10 texts, 1558-1569.
- Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse) (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 27 texts, 1523-1582.
- County of Lippe (Sehling 21, §1.32): 1 text, 1600.
- Archbishopric of Cologne (Sehling 22, §1.33): 2 texts, 1583.
- County of Wittgenstein (Sehling 22, §1.33): 10 texts, 1579-1611.
- County of Moers (Sehling 22, §1.33): 3 texts, 1581-1603.
- County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Sehling 22, §1.33): 10 texts, 1601-1619.

### 1.3.3 Moderate Reformed (MR) and Philippist (PH)

Between the Lutheran and the Swiss Reformed stood two groups of orders. They are coded apart, and where an order could belong to either, it is counted as Moderate Reformed.

**Moderate Reformed (MR)**, 198 texts: the Bucerian and Upper German orders, and others close to them:

- the Upper German Reformation of Bucer, Capito, Blarer and Zwick in the southern imperial cities before the Interim;

- Philip of Hesse's church, which bore Bucer's stamp. Bucer had a decisive share in the orders of 1539, and Philip's testament gave the Wittenberg Concord, Bucer's work, almost confessional weight. The editors place the Kirchenordnung of 1566 in the Strasbourg sphere;
- Hermann von Wied's Cologne order (written by Bucer and Melanchthon);
- a few early evangelical orders that moved toward Zurich (Rothmann's Münster) or took their pastors from Basel and ended Reformed (Colmar after 1578), and East Frisia under Countess Anna and John a Lasco.
- East Frisia: comital orders (Sehling 7/1, §1.13): 1 text, 1545.
- Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567) (Sehling 8, §1.16): 21 texts, 1526-1566.
- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 4 texts, 1530-1533.
- Imperial city of Augsburg (Sehling 12, §1.20): 13 texts, 1523-1548.
- Imperial city of Lindau (Sehling 12, §1.20): 3 texts, 1533-1539.
- Imperial city of Memmingen (Sehling 12, §1.20): 4 texts, 1528-1542.
- Imperial city of Konstanz (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 19 texts, 1524-1548.
- Imperial city of Isny (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 2 texts, 1533-1544.
- Imperial city of Gengenbach (Sehling 17/1, §1.25): 8 texts, 1538-1545.
- Imperial city of Ulm (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 15 texts, 1528-1544.
- Imperial city of Esslingen (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 34 texts, 1531-1547.
- Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß (Sehling 17/2, §1.26): 3 texts, 1531-1548.
- Imperial city of Landau (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 5 texts, 1526-1554.
- Imperial city of Worms (Sehling 19/1, §1.28): 3 texts, 1524-1543.
- Imperial city of Strasbourg (Sehling 20/1, §1.30): 46 texts, 1523-1548.
- Imperial city of Colmar (Sehling 20/2, §1.31): 12 texts, 1578-1615.
- Archbishopric of Cologne (Sehling 22, §1.33): 1 text, 1546.
- City of Münster (Sehling 22, §1.33): 4 texts, 1532-1533.

**Philippist (PH)**, 33 texts: churches that held to Melanchthon's later teaching and his *Corpus doctrinae* of 1560, and would not accept the Formula of Concord. Most of them later turned Reformed:

- the joint synods of the Hessian landgraviates (1568-1582), which took the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* as their norm, and the Hessian orders that followed to 1598;
- Bremen, from Albert Hardenberg's dispute (1556) to the Reformed turn of 1580;
- Nassau-Dillenburg's Agende of 1575, which binds the pastors to the Augsburg Confession and the *Examen* of Philip Melanchthon;
- Anhalt under Prince Johann Georg before the Reformed turn of 1596.
- Principality of Anhalt (Sehling 2, §1.7): 2 texts, 1590-1594.
- City of Bremen (Sehling 7/2.2, §1.15): 9 texts, 1556-1575.
- The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582) (Sehling 8, §1.16): 16 texts, 1568-1582.

- Divided Hesse (1582-1618) (Sehling 9, §1.17): 5 texts, 1574-1598.
- Nassau-Dillenburg (Sehling 10, §1.18): 1 text, 1575.

#### 1.3.4 Anglican (A)

One order in the set is Anglican: the "Old Discipline" and "New Discipline" of the English exile congregation at Frankfurt (1557). It was founded in 1554 by Marian exiles under Whittingham and John Knox. In 1555 a second group under Richard Cox, loyal to the Book of Common Prayer, took the lead and drove Knox out. **Frankfurt, editor's introduction** (Sehling 9, p. 492):

> Obwohl die englische Gemeinde nach Wegzug der Knox'schen Fraktion durchweg anglikanischen Charakter besaß, lässt die New Discipline innerhalb des bestehenden Rahmens des Second Book of Common Prayer Züge gemeindlicher Weiterentwicklung erkennen.

Although, after the departure of Knox's faction, the English congregation was thoroughly Anglican in character, the New Discipline shows traits of congregational development within the existing framework of the Second Book of Common Prayer.

- Imperial city of Frankfurt (Sehling 9, §1.17): 1 text, 1557.

Sehling calls the congregation "englisch-reformiert". It is coded A here because the editor shows that its order was framed within the Prayer Book.

Two related orders are coded R:

- the order of John a Lasco's Dutch stranger church in London under Edward VI, in Micron's German abridgement (Sehling 7/1, p. 579);
- the French Reformed congregation's *Liturgia sacra* of 1554 at Frankfurt (Sehling 9, p. 562). Frankfurt also required the English congregation to use it.

#### 1.3.5 Hussite: the Bohemian Brethren (H), and the Sandomierz consensus (C)

The Hussite tradition reaches the set through the Unity of the Brethren (Unitas Fratrum) in Greater Poland. **Greater Poland, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 4, p. 248):

> In Polen verbreitete sich sowohl die lutherische als auch die reformirte Lehre gleichzeitig. Daneben entstanden Gemeinden der böhmischen Brüder in grösserer Zahl.

In Poland both the Lutheran and the Reformed teaching spread at the same time. Alongside them arose congregations of the Bohemian Brethren in large numbers.

The Brethren had united with the Little Polish Reformed at Koźminek in 1555. In 1570, at Sandomierz, they joined with the Reformed and the Lutherans in a common Consensus. Sehling prints the Ostroróg privilege because of the town's place in the Unity. **Greater Poland, Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 4, p. 254):

> Da Ostrorog die Hauptgemeinde der Unität war und Sitz des Seniors, soll dieses Privileg nach einer mir gütigst zur Verfügung gestellten Übersetzung abgedruckt werden.

Since Ostroróg was the chief congregation of the Unity and the seat of the senior, this privilege shall be printed from a translation kindly placed at my disposal.

The Brethren (H):

- Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns (Sehling 4, §1.9): 3 texts, 1569-1616.
  - Kirchenordnung der Böhmischen Brüder (1616; Sehling 4, p. 273).
  - Privileg für Lissa (1580; Sehling 4, p. 298).
  - Privileg für Ostrorog (1569; Sehling 4, p. 299).

The Sandomierz consensus and its general synods (C):

- Synode von Sendomir (1570; Sehling 4, p. 257).

- Synode von Posen (1570; Sehling 4, p. 258).
- Synode von Krakau (1573; Sehling 4, p. 260).
- Synode von Petrikau (1578; Sehling 4, p. 262).
- Synode von Wladislaw (1583; Sehling 4, p. 263).
- Synode von Thorn (1595; Sehling 4, p. 265).

The synods of Xions (1560) and Pińczów (1561) belong to the Little Polish Reformed church united with the Brethren, and are coded R. The Lutheran synod of Gostyń (1565) and the town orders of Fraustadt are coded L.

The Brethren's order of 1616 was adopted by their general synod at Zerawitz in Moravia; Sehling prints it for the Polish congregations. No Utraquist order is in the set.

#### 1.3.6 Others

- **Roman Catholic humanist, Erasmian reform (RCH).** The church orders of Duke Johann III of Jülich-Cleves-Berg (1532/33) and their successors. They reform the old church on humanist lines without leaving it (Sehling 21; §1.32.1).
- **Multi-confessional diet decrees (T).** The decrees of the Transylvanian diets (1552-1619) regulate a principality that received the Lutheran, Reformed, Unitarian and Catholic religions side by side. The Transylvanian Saxons' own orders are Lutheran. The *Consensus doctrinae* of 1557 is also coded L (Sehling 24; §1.35).
- **Radical Reformation (RAD).** Thomas Müntzer's German church office, German evangelical Mass and order of the German service at Allstedt (1523/24). They are coded apart from the Lutheran orders around them in vol. 1.
- **Anabaptist (ANA).** The Münster council and guild masters' mandate of 31 January 1534, three weeks before the Anabaptist council was elected. It bound the citizens to let each keep his faith, and so recognized the Anabaptists as a religious group in the city (Sehling 22, p. 363). It is not an order made by Anabaptists: no Anabaptist church order is in the set.
- **Roman Catholic (RC).** Bishop Franz von Waldeck's edict of 3 February 1534 against the "verdampte ketterye unnde secte der wedderdoep" (Sehling 22, p. 364).
- **Groups with no order in the set.** There are no orders of the Waldensians (named only in passing, by Luther and in the editors' notes), the Lollards, the Utraquists, the Schwenckfelders, the Hutterites, the Mennonites or the Antitrinitarians. Mandates against Anabaptists, Schwenckfelders, Davidjorists, Mennonites and "Sakramentierer" are coded by the authority that issued them: Lutheran, Reformed, Moderate Reformed or, in Jülich, Roman Catholic humanist.
- **Treaty (R/L).** The East Frisian Delfzijl settlement of 1595 and the Concordats of 1599, between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.

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### 1.4 The Interim orders

The Augsburg Interim of 1548 imposed a largely Catholic order on the Protestant estates until a final council, allowing only the chalice and clerical marriage. The Leipzig Interim (1548/49) was Electoral Saxony's milder version. As §1.2.2 shows, Sehling meant to print no Interim orders. Those in the set fall into four groups:

- **Interim order**: an order made to put the Interim into effect, or to adapt a territory's order to it;
- **under the Interim**: a text issued while the Interim was in force, not itself an Interim order;
- **on the Interim**: a text about the Interim, such as a response, a settlement or a protest;
- **after the Interim** or **end of the Interim**: a text that ends or repairs it.

| Order | Date | Territory | Sehling | Doc | Interim | Trad. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ostfriesische Interimsordnung, 16. Juli 1549 (printed in the editor's introduction, n. 51) | 1549 | East Frisia: comital orders | 7/1, p. 328 | 2105 | Interim order | L |
| Im Auftrag des Rates verfaßte Stellungnahme der Prädikanten zum Interim [14. Juli 1548] | 1548 | Imperial city of Goslar | 7/2.2, p. 290 | 2199 | On the Interim | L |

| Order | Date | Territory | Sehling | Doc | Interim | Trad. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Die „Neue Ordnung“ 25. September 1548 | 1548 | Imperial city of Goslar | 7/2.2, p. 293 | 2200 | Interim year (civic order) | L |
| Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung. 1548 | 1548 | Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533) | 11, p. 325 | 277 | Interim order | L |
| Bußvermahnung wegen des Verhaltens während des Interims vom 22. Juni 1552 | 1552 | Imperial city of Regensburg | 13, p. 417 | 439 | After the Interim | L |
| Interimsmandat 1548 | 1548 | Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16, p. 166 | 661 | Interim order | L |
| Mandat zur Wiederanstellung evangelischer Prediger 1549 | 1549 | Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16, p. 168 | 662 | Under the Interim | L |
| Kirchenratsmandat 1548 | 1548 | Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16, p. 169 | 663 | Under the Interim | L |
| Predigtmandat 1550 | 1550 | Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16, p. 197 | 667 | Under the Interim | L |
| Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe 1552 | 1552 | Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16, p. 198 | 668 | End of the Interim | L |
| Täufermandate: Verbot, mit den Täufern Handel zu treiben 1548 | 1548 | Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall | 17/1, p. 195 | 763 | Under the Interim | L |
| Statuten des Landkapitels [1553] | 1553 | Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall | 17/1, p. 197 | 763 | Under the Interim | L |
| Ratsmandat für die Prediger zur Gewissensfreiheit nach Annahme des Interims [1548] | 1548 | Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß | 17/2, p. 449 | 907 | Interim order | MR |
| Täufermandat [1549] | 1549 | Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß | 17/2, p. 451 | 908 | Under the Interim | L |
| Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung [Nach 2. Juli] 1548 | 1548 | Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1, p. 352 | 1316 | On the Interim | MR |
| Agende für die Taufe und Trauung 27. Juni 1549 | 1549 | Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1, p. 357 | 1317 | Under the Interim | L |
| Examensordnung 1549 | 1549 | Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1, p. 364 | 1318 | Under the Interim | L |
| Schiedsvertrag zwischen dem Bischof von Straßburg und dem Magistrat der Stadt über die Durchführung … | 1549 | Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1, p. 368 | 1319 | Interim settlement | L |
| Mandat zum Schutz des katholischen Gottesdienstes [4. Februar 1550] | 1550 | Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1, p. 372 | 1320 | Under the Interim | L |

| Order | Date | Territory | Sehling | Doc | Interim | Trad. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mandat zum Abendmahl unter beiderlei Gestalt 1552 | 1552 | City of Soest | 22, p. 472 | 1531 | After the Interim | L |

Several orders of the set are **described but not printed** because they are Interim orders:

- the Saxon (Leipzig) Interim agenda of 1549 (Sehling 1, p. 102; Sehling 2, pp. 501-505);
- the planned Hamburg Interim church order (Sehling 5, p. 484);
- the Brandenburg Interim order (Sehling 3, pp. 12, 177);
- the Göttingen "KO unter dem Interim" of 1550 (Sehling 6/2, p. 904);
- the Nuremberg Interim agenda (Sehling 11, pp. 328, 482);
- the Augsburg Interim forms (Sehling 12, p. 28);
- the draft of a Prussian church order "auf der Grundlage des Interims" (Sehling 4, p. 22).

Some cities kept Interim usages long after 1552. Schwäbisch Hall kept its Interim order until 1559 (Sehling 17/1, p. 34), and in Ansbach-Kulmbach the Mass vestment stayed "als Rest der Interimszeit" (Sehling 11, p. 292).

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## 1.5 The territories at a glance

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Martin Luther's orders | 1 | 1.6.1 | 9 | 1523-1526 | Lutheran |
| Saxony: editor's introductions | 1 | 1.6.2 | 14 | 1527-1578 | Lutheran |
| Ernestine Saxony | 1 | 1.6.3 | 26 | 1527-1580 | Lutheran |
| Albertine Saxony | 1 | 1.6.4 | 23 | 1539-1580 | Lutheran |
| Freiberg and Wolkenstein (Duke Henry) | 1 | 1.6.5 | 3 | 1537-1538 | Lutheran |
| Towns of Ernestine and Albertine Saxony | 1 | 1.6.6 | 133 | 1522-1582 | Lutheran |
| Bishoprics of Merseburg, Meissen, Naumburg-Zeitz and Wurzen | 2 | 1.7.1 | 21 | 1527-1578 | Lutheran |
| Amt Stolpen and Bischofswerda | 2 | 1.7.2 | 2 | 1559-1559 | Lutheran |
| Lordship and town of Plauen | 2 | 1.7.3 | 2 | 1529-1532 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Ronneburg | 2 | 1.7.4 | 1 | 1529-1529 | Lutheran |
| Schwarzburg | 2 | 1.7.5 | 8 | 1532-1587 | Lutheran |
| Reuss | 2 | 1.7.6 | 8 | 1532-1560 | Lutheran |
| Schönburg | 2 | 1.7.7 | 2 | 1542-1582 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Harz counties (Mansfeld, Stolberg, Hohenstein, Regenstein, Quedlinburg) | 2 | 1.7.8 | 9 | 1540–1586 | Lutheran |
| County of Henneberg | 2 | 1.7.9 | 27 | 1545–1635 | Lutheran |
| Mainz possessions (Eichsfeld, Erfurt, Querfurt) | 2 | 1.7.10 | 4 | 1525–1583 | Lutheran |
| Imperial cities of Mühlhausen and Nordhausen | 2 | 1.7.11 | 6 | 1541–1571 | Lutheran |
| Archbishopric of Magdeburg and Bishopric of Halberstadt | 2 | 1.7.12 | 28 | 1524–1589 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Anhalt | 2 | 1.7.13 | 32 | 1532–1599 | Lutheran; Philippist from 1590; Reformed from 1596 |
| Naumburg cathedral (supplement) | 2 | 1.7.14 | 1 | 1543–1543 | Lutheran |
| Electorate of Brandenburg | 3 | 1.8.1 | 7 | 1540–1600 | Lutheran |
| Lordships of Beeskow and Storkow | 3 | 1.8.2 | 3 | 1570–1585 | Lutheran |
| Lands of the von der Schulenburg family | 3 | 1.8.3 | 1 | 1572–1572 | Lutheran |
| Towns of the Mark Brandenburg | 3 | 1.8.4 | 57 | 1540–1603 | Lutheran |
| Upper and Lower Lusatia | 3 | 1.8.5 | 14 | 1525–1595 | Lutheran |
| Silesia | 3 | 1.8.6 | 35 | 1521–1592 | Lutheran |
| Duchy of Prussia | 4 | 1.9.1 | 38 | 1524–1588 | Lutheran |
| Royal Prussia: Danzig, Elbing, Thorn and their lands | 4 | 1.9.2 | 23 | 1525–1612 | Lutheran |
| Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns | 4 | 1.9.3 | 18 | 1560–1616 | Sandomierz consensus |
| Duchy of Pomerania | 4 | 1.9.4 | 47 | 1525–1616 | Lutheran |
| Livonia | 5 | 1.10.1 | 8 | 1530–1554 | Lutheran |
| Estonia (Reval) | 5 | 1.10.2 | 5 | 1524–1525 | Lutheran |
| Courland | 5 | 1.10.3 | 11 | 1560–1591 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg | 5 | 1.10.4 | 43 | 1530–1585 | Lutheran |
| Lübeck with Bergedorf | 5 | 1.10.5 | 11 | 1531–1588 | Lutheran |
| Lauenburg and the Land Hadeln | 5 | 1.10.6 | 3 | 1542–1599 | Lutheran |
| Hamburg | 5 | 1.10.7 | 5 | 1529–1570 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Wolfenbüttel | 6/1 | 1.11.1 | 4 | 1542–1569 | Lutheran |
| Town of Braunschweig | 6/1 | 1.11.2 | 7 | 1528–1571 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Lüneburg | 6/1 | 1.11.3 | 10 | 1527–1583 | Lutheran |
| Town of Lüneburg | 6/1 | 1.11.4 | 5 | 1531–1598 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen | 6/2 | 1.12.1 | 12 | 1542–1601 | Lutheran |
| Town of Göttingen | 6/2 | 1.12.2 | 2 | 1531–1568 | Lutheran |
| Town of Northeim | 6/2 | 1.12.3 | 1 | 1539–1539 | Lutheran |
| Town of Hannover | 6/2 | 1.12.4 | 1 | 1536–1536 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Grubenhagen | 6/2 | 1.12.5 | 7 | 1538–1600 | Lutheran |
| Town of Einbeck | 6/2 | 1.12.6 | 1 | 1543–1543 | Lutheran |
| Counties of Hoya and Diepholz | 6/2 | 1.12.7 | 2 | 1571–1581 | Lutheran |
| Archbishopric of Bremen | 7/1 | 1.13.1 | 8 | 1574–1616 | Lutheran |
| Town of Stade | 7/1 | 1.13.2 | 1 | 1620–1620 | Lutheran |
| Town of Buxtehude | 7/1 | 1.13.3 | 2 | 1552–1565 | Lutheran |
| Bishopric of Verden | 7/1 | 1.13.4 | 1 | 1606–1606 | Lutheran |
| Bishopric of Osnabrück | 7/1 | 1.13.5 | 3 | 1543–1543 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Town of Osnabrück | 7/1 | 1.13.6 | 5 | 1543-1618 | Lutheran |
| East Frisia: comital orders | 7/1 | 1.13.7 | 6 | 1529-1549 | Lutheran |
| East Frisia: treaties | 7/1 | 1.13.8 | 2 | 1595-1599 | Reformed/Lutheran |
| East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London) | 7/1 | 1.13.9 | 15 | 1528-1606 | Reformed |
| East Frisia and Harlingerland: Lutheran orders of limited range | 7/1 | 1.13.10 | 4 | 1574-1593 | Lutheran |
| Bishopric of Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine) | 7/2.1 | 1.14.1 | 3 | 1560-1574 | Lutheran |
| Town of Hildesheim | 7/2.1 | 1.14.2 | 14 | 1543-1597 | Lutheran |
| County of Oldenburg | 7/2.1 | 1.14.3 | 9 | 1573-1609 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Jever | 7/2.1 | 1.14.4 | 11 | 1558-1596 | Lutheran |
| County of Schaumburg | 7/2.2 | 1.15.1 | 25 | 1559-1615 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Goslar | 7/2.2 | 1.15.2 | 35 | 1528-1617 | Lutheran |
| City of Bremen | 7/2.2 | 1.15.3 | 38 | 1525-1616 | Lutheran; Philippist from 1562; Reformed from 1580 |
| Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567) | 8 | 1.16.1 | 21 | 1526-1566 | Moderate Reformed |
| The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582) | 8 | 1.16.2 | 16 | 1568-1582 | Philippist |
| Divided Hesse (1582-1618) | 9 | 1.17.1 | 19 | 1574-1618 | Philippist; Reformed (Hessen-Kassel) from 1600 |
| County of Waldeck | 9 | 1.17.2 | 27 | 1525-1590 | Lutheran |
| County of Solms | 9 | 1.17.3 | 10 | 1580-1616 | Lutheran |
| County of Erbach | 9 | 1.17.4 | 6 | 1544-1587 | Lutheran |
| County of Stolberg-Königstein | 9 | 1.17.5 | 1 | 1540-1540 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Frankfurt | 9 | 1.17.6 | 26 | 1530-1618 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1535 |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Imperial castle and city of Friedberg | 9 | 1.17.7 | 4 | 1565-1619 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Gelnhausen | 9 | 1.17.8 | 3 | 1566-1599 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Wetzlar | 9 | 1.17.9 | 5 | 1561-1596 | Lutheran |
| Nassau-Dillenburg | 10 | 1.18.1 | 29 | 1532-1618 | Lutheran; Philippist from 1573; Reformed from 1578 |
| Nassau-Weilburg and Nassau-Saarbrücken | 10 | 1.18.2 | 7 | 1554-1617 | Lutheran |
| Nassau-Wiesbaden and Nassau-Idstein | 10 | 1.18.3 | 4 | 1582-1590 | Lutheran |
| County of Hanau-Münzenberg | 10 | 1.18.4 | 29 | 1543-1614 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1595 |
| County of Ysenburg | 10 | 1.18.5 | 30 | 1544-1614 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Nuremberg (to 1528) | 11 | 1.19.1 | 8 | 1522-1526 | Lutheran |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (to 1528) | 11 | 1.19.2 | 11 | 1523-1528 | Lutheran |
| Brandenburg and Nuremberg together (1528-1533) | 11 | 1.19.3 | 6 | 1528-1533 | Lutheran |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533) | 11 | 1.19.4 | 21 | 1526-1594 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Nuremberg (from 1533) | 11 | 1.19.5 | 3 | 1545-1582 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Rothenburg ob der Tauber | 11 | 1.19.6 | 2 | 1558-1559 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Schweinfurt with Gochsheim and Sennfeld | 11 | 1.19.7 | 3 | 1543-1576 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Weißenburg (Franconia) | 11 | 1.19.8 | 2 | 1528-1590 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Windsheim | 11 | 1.19.9 | 1 | 1524-1524 | Lutheran |
| County of Castell | 11 | 1.19.10 | 1 | 1579-1579 | Lutheran |
| County of Rieneck | 11 | 1.19.11 | 2 | 1544-1588 | Lutheran |
| County of Wertheim | 11 | 1.19.12 | 2 | 1524-1555 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lordship of Thüngen | 11 | 1.19.13 | 2 | 1564-1587 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Augsburg | 12 | 1.20.1 | 17 | 1523-1591 | Moderate Reformed (Rhegius's baptism rite Lutheran); Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Dinkelsbühl | 12 | 1.20.2 | 9 | 1535-1574 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Donauwörth | 12 | 1.20.3 | 1 | 1545-1545 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Kempten | 12 | 1.20.4 | 1 | 1553-1553 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Lindau | 12 | 1.20.5 | 5 | 1533-1573 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Memmingen | 12 | 1.20.6 | 5 | 1528-1569 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Nördlingen | 12 | 1.20.7 | 7 | 1522-1579 | Lutheran |
| County of Oettingen-Oettingen | 12 | 1.20.8 | 1 | 1591-1591 | Lutheran |
| Duchy of Pfalz-Neuburg | 13 | 1.21.1 | 28 | 1542-1577 | Lutheran |
| Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate) | 13 | 1.21.2 | 22 | 1544-1615 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1559; Lutheran from 1577; Reformed from 1583 |
| Imperial city of Regensburg | 13 | 1.21.3 | 24 | 1542-1599 | Lutheran |
| County of Ortenburg | 13 | 1.21.4 | 3 | 1563-1578 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Rothenberg | 13 | 1.21.5 | 3 | 1601-1618 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Wolfstein | 13 | 1.21.6 | 2 | 1574-1574 | Lutheran |
| Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz) | 14 | 1.22.1 | 110 | 1546-1615 | Lutheran; Reformed 1561-1576; Lutheran 1577-1583 (Reformed in Pfalz-Lautern); Reformed from 1583 |
| County of Hohenlohe | 15 | 1.23.1 | 108 | 1544-1615 | Lutheran |
| Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg) | 16 | 1.24.1 | 73 | 1534-1614 | Lutheran |
| Margraviate of Baden | 16 | 1.24.2 | 21 | 1528-1617 | Lutheran |
| County of Limpurg | 16 | 1.24.3 | 9 | 1537-1620 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lordship of Kinzigtal (Fürstenberg) | 16 | 1.24.4 | 4 | 1542–1546 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim | 16 | 1.24.5 | 1 | 1560–1560 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall | 17/1 | 1.25.1 | 21 | 1526–1615 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Heilbronn | 17/1 | 1.25.2 | 18 | 1528–1603 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Konstanz | 17/1 | 1.25.3 | 19 | 1524–1548 | Moderate Reformed |
| Imperial city of Isny | 17/1 | 1.25.4 | 5 | 1533–1600 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Gengenbach | 17/1 | 1.25.5 | 8 | 1538–1545 | Moderate Reformed |
| Württemberg: school orders of the Great Church Order of 1559 (supplement to vol. 16) | 17/1 | 1.25.6 | 7 | 1559–1559 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Reutlingen | 17/2 | 1.26.1 | 5 | 1528–1574 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Ulm | 17/2 | 1.26.2 | 35 | 1528–1600 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Esslingen | 17/2 | 1.26.3 | 40 | 1531–1602 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Giengen an der Brenz | 17/2 | 1.26.4 | 1 | 1583–1583 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß | 17/2 | 1.26.5 | 6 | 1531–1563 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| Imperial city of Ravensburg | 17/2 | 1.26.6 | 11 | 1545–1610 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Wimpfen | 17/2 | 1.26.7 | 8 | 1545–1589 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Leutkirch | 17/2 | 1.26.8 | 5 | 1562–1605 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Bopfingen | 17/2 | 1.26.9 | 3 | 1546–1607 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Aalen | 17/2 | 1.26.10 | 2 | 1575–1576 | Lutheran |
| Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken | 18 | 1.27.1 | 42 | 1533–1617 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1588 |
| County of Pfalz-Veldenz with Lützelstein and Guttenberg | 18 | 1.27.2 | 6 | 1558–1605 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Counties of Sponheim | 18 | 1.27.3 | 11 | 1560-1617 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Sickingen | 18 | 1.27.4 | 2 | 1564-1572 | Lutheran |
| County of Manderscheid-Schleiden | 18 | 1.27.5 | 1 | 1566-1566 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Landau | 19/1 | 1.28.1 | 12 | 1526-1611 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1555 |
| Imperial city of Speyer | 19/1 | 1.28.2 | 10 | 1525-1612 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Worms | 19/1 | 1.28.3 | 4 | 1524-1560 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1552 |
| Counties of Leiningen | 19/1 | 1.28.4 | 11 | 1566-1617 | Lutheran |
| County of Sayn | 19/1 | 1.28.5 | 16 | 1560-1619 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1605 |
| County of Wied | 19/1 | 1.28.6 | 8 | 1564-1619 | Reformed |
| Wild- and Rhinegraviate | 19/2 | 1.29.1 | 22 | 1563-1618 | Lutheran |
| Principality of Pfalz-Simmern | 19/2 | 1.29.2 | 3 | 1560-1598 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1598 |
| County of Pfalz-Veldenz (supplement to vol. 18) | 19/2 | 1.29.3 | 1 | 1571-1571 | Lutheran |
| Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14) | 19/2 | 1.29.4 | 72 | 1546-1610 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1561; Lutheran from 1577 (Reformed in Pfalz-Lautern); Reformed from 1583 |
| Imperial city of Strasbourg | 20/1 | 1.30.1 | 79 | 1523-1617 | Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549 |
| County of Hanau-Lichtenberg | 20/2 | 1.31.1 | 7 | 1545-1614 | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Fleckenstein | 20/2 | 1.31.2 | 1 | n.d. | Lutheran |
| Lordship of Rappoltstein | 20/2 | 1.31.3 | 12 | 1553-1569 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse) | 20/2 | 1.31.4 | 27 | 1523-1582 | Reformed |
| Imperial city of Weißenburg (Alsace) | 20/2 | 1.31.5 | 2 | 1560-1613 | Lutheran |
| Münster im Gregoriental | 20/2 | 1.31.6 | 7 | 1575-1604 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Imperial city of Hagenau | 20/2 | 1.31.7 | 12 | 1565-1617 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Colmar | 20/2 | 1.31.8 | 16 | 1575-1615 | Lutheran; Moderate Reformed from 1578 |
| United Duchies of Jülich-Cleves-Berg | 21 | 1.32.1 | 18 | 1525-1572 | Roman Catholic humanist |
| Bishopric and town of Minden | 21 | 1.32.2 | 7 | 1530-1604 | Lutheran |
| Imperial abbey and town of Herford | 21 | 1.32.3 | 1 | 1532-1532 | Lutheran |
| Imperial city of Dortmund | 21 | 1.32.4 | 6 | 1532-1596 | Lutheran |
| Imperial abbey of Corvey (Höxter) | 21 | 1.32.5 | 3 | 1533-1603 | Lutheran |
| County of Lippe | 21 | 1.32.6 | 12 | 1537-1617 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1600 |
| Imperial abbey and town of Essen | 21 | 1.32.7 | 5 | 1561-1581 | Lutheran |
| Archbishopric of Cologne | 22 | 1.33.1 | 3 | 1546-1583 | Moderate Reformed; Reformed from 1583 |
| County of Wittgenstein | 22 | 1.33.2 | 21 | 1555-1611 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1574 |
| County of Moers | 22 | 1.33.3 | 6 | 1561-1603 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1578 |
| County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg | 22 | 1.33.4 | 12 | 1543-1619 | Lutheran; Reformed from 1586 |
| County of Rietberg | 22 | 1.33.5 | 2 | 1566-1568 | Lutheran |
| City of Münster | 22 | 1.33.6 | 6 | 1532-1534 | Moderate Reformed |
| City of Soest | 22 | 1.33.7 | 13 | 1532-1619 | Lutheran |
| Town of Neuenrade | 22 | 1.33.8 | 1 | 1564-1564 | Lutheran |
| County of Lippe (supplement) | 22 | 1.33.9 | 1 | 1538-1538 | Lutheran |
| Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein | 23 | 1.34.1 | 68 | 1526-1617 | Lutheran |
| Land of Dithmarschen | 23 | 1.34.2 | 20 | 1532-1606 | Lutheran |

| Territory | Sehling | § | Texts | Years | Tradition |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Principality of Transylvania: diets | 24 | 1.35.1 | 26 | 1552-1619 | Multi-confessional |
| Transylvanian Saxons | 24 | 1.35.2 | 95 | 1543-1620 | Lutheran |

## 1.6 Volume 1: Saxony and Thuringia I: Luther; Ernestine and Albertine Saxony

208 texts.

### 1.6.1 Martin Luther's orders

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Luther, Von ordnung gottis diensts in der gemeine | 1523 | 1, p. 2 | 2 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 10 | Luther, Formula missae | 1523 | 1, p. 3 | 2 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 17 | Luther, Deutsche Messe | 1526 | 1, p. 10 | 2 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 1 | Luther, Wie man recht und vorstendlich ein menschen taufen sol | n.d. | 1, p. 17 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 11 | Luther, Das taufbuchlein verdeutscht | 1523 | 1, p. 18 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 18 | Luther, Das taufbüchlein verdeutscht, aufs neu zugericht | 1526 | 1, p. 21 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Luther, Traubüchlein für die einfeltigen pfarherrn | n.d. | 1, p. 23 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Luther, Formula ordinandorum ministrorum verbi | n.d. | 1, p. 26 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Luther, Formula ordinationis latina, que usurpatur , quando peregrini.germanicum linguam non intelligunt | n.d. | 1, p. 27 | 3 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.6.2 Saxony: editor's introductions

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Orders printed in whole or part in Sehling's introduction.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | Die artikel so durch die rethe zur visitation .. .. bedacht | 1527 | 1, p. 37 | 6 | Visitation | L | |
| 68 | Schmiedeberg. Ordnung der Visitatoren | 1533 | 1, p. 51 | 6 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 86 | Abschied der Visitatoren für Grimma | 1534 | 1, p. 53 | 6 | Visitation | L | |
| 87 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Eilenburg | 1534 | 1, p. 53 | 6 | Visitation | L | |
| 132 | Reskript Johann Friedrich des Mittleren. Vom 23. October 1551 | 1551 | 1, p. 61 | 6 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 133 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Saalfeld | 1554 | 1, p. 63 | 6 | Visitation | L | |
| 169 | Drei Examensartikel für Weimar | 1573 | 1, p. 68 | 6 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 189 | Verordnung des Kurfürsten August vom 13. Oct | 1578 | 1, p. 77 | 6 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 138 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Kemberg | 1555 | 1, p. 106 | 7 | Visitation | L | |
| 161 | Investitur des Pfarrers von Wittenberg | 1569 | 1, p. 107 | 7 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 190 | Propositio des ersten Generalsynodus zu Dresden 1578 | 1578 | 1, p. 113 | 7 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 191 | Siebenlehn. Bericht auf der Visitation von 1578 | 1578 | 1, p. 126 | 7 | Visitation | L | |
| 192 | Weissenborn. Bericht auf der Visitation. 1578 | 1578 | 1, p. 126 | 7 | Visitation | L | |
| 193 | Bericht aus der Superintendenz Chemnitz 1578 | 1578 | 1, p. 127 | 7 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.6.3 Ernestine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | Instruktion der Visitatoren. 16. Juni 1527 | 1527 | 1, p. 142 | 8 | Visitation | L | |
| 21 | Herzog Hansen churfursten artikel | 1527 | 1, p. 148 | 8 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| | Unterricht der visitatoren im kurfürstenthum zu Sachsen | 1528 | 1, p. 149 | 9 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 96 | Revision des „Unterricht der Visitatoren“ durch Luther | 1538 | 1, p. 149 | 9 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 14 | Verordnung betr. Ankündigung der Visitation, 6. Sept. 1528 | 1527 | 1, p. 174 | 10 | Visitation | L | |
| 25 | Verordnung aus der Visitation von 1528/1529 | 1527 | 1, p. 175 | 11 | Visitation | L | |
| 31 | Verordnungen aus der Visitation 1528/1529 | 1529 | 1, p. 175 | 11 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 66 | Ausschreiben durchs churfürstenthumb zu Sachsen vom 6. Juni 1531 | 1531 | 1, p. 178 | 12 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 67 | Instruktion zur Visitation | 1532 | 1, p. 183 | 13 | Visitation | L | |
| 69 | Gemeine verordnung der visitation in Meissen und der Voitland | 1533 | 1, p. 187 | 14 | Visitation | L | |
| 120 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Wurzen | 1542 | 1, p. 187 | 14 | Visitation | L | |
| 70 | Artikel gemeiner Verschaffung, aus der visitation in Thüringen | 1533 | 1, p. 195 | 15 | Visitation | L | |
| 71 | Verordnung für Adel und Ritterschaft des Orts Franken | 1533 | 1, p. 197 | 16 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 92 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Franken | 1535 | 1, p. 198 | 17 | Visitation | L | |
| 72 | Patent betr. die geistlichen Zinse. 4. Decbr | 1533 | 1, p. 200 | 18 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 121 | Constitution des consistorii zu Wittenberg | 1542 | 1, p. 200 | 18 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 125 | Wittenbergische Reformation | 1545 | 1, p. 209 | 20 | Church order | L | |
| 134 | Visitationsinstruktion vom 17. Juni 1554 | 1554 | 1, p. 222 | 20 | Visitation | L | |
| 152 | Polizei- und landsordnung, im Ernestinischen Sachsen | 1556 | 1, p. 228 | 21 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 157 | Ordnung und summarischer process des consistorii (zu Weimar) | 1561 | 1, p. 230 | 23 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 162 | Ordnung und reformation consistorii zu Jena | 1569 | 1, p. 233 | 24 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 163 | Instruktion Johann Wilhelms zur Partikularvisitation | 1569 | 1, p. 242 | 24 | Visitation | L | |
| 164 | Process oder memoriale der visitation | 1569 | 1, p. 245 | 24 | Visitation | L | |
| 170 | Consistorial-Ordnung zu Jena | 1574 | 1, p. 248 | 25 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 204 | Beschlüsse des Coburgischen Synodus | 1580 | 1, p. 252 | 26 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 98 | Instruktion für die erste Visitation Herzog Heinrichs | 1539 | 1, p. 257 | 27 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.6.4 Albertine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 99 | Die vier artikel den dorfpfarrern furgehalten | 1539 | 1, p. 263 | 29 | Other | L | |
| 100 | Kirchen-Ordnung zum anfang ..... in herzog Heinrichs zu Sachsen fürstenthum | 1539 | 1, p. 264 | 30 | Church order | L | |
| 101 | Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation | 1539 | 1, p. 281 | 31 | Visitation | L | |
| 112 | Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren an die pfarrer in herzog Heinrichs ... lande | 1540 | 1, p. 284 | 32 | Visitation | L | |
| 123 | Ordnung Herzogs Moritz. 21. Mai | 1543 | 1, p. 286 | 32 | Local order | L | |
| 124 | Ordnung Herzogs Moritz. 21. Mai | 1543 | 1, p. 290 | 32 | Local order | L | |
| 126 | a) Consistorial-Ordnung | 1545 | 1, p. 291 | 33 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 127 | b) Ehebedenken | 1545 | 1, p. 292 | 33 | Marriage | L | |
| 128 | c) Kirchen-Ordnung | 1545 | 1, p. 297 | 33 | Church order | L | |
| 129 | Ausschreiben des Herzogs Augustus, betr. die heimlichen Verlöbnisse | 1545 | 1, p. 304 | 34 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 139 | Instruktion zur Visitation | 1555 | 1, p. 305 | 35 | Visitation | L | |
| 140 | Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende | 1555 | 1, p. 311 | 36 | Visitation | L | |
| 155 | General - Artikel des Kurfürsten August. Vom 8. Mai | 1557 | 1, p. 316 | 36 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 141 | Landes-Ordnung des Kurfürsten August. Vom 1. October | 1555 | 1, p. 340 | 38 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 153 | Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung | 1556 | 1, p. 343 | 39 | Marriage | L | |
| 185 | Visitations - Instruktion des Kurfürsten August. Vom 4. Juni | 1577 | 1, p. 346 | 39 | Visitation | L | |
| 186 | Visitations-Instruktion des Kurfürsten August für das Ernestinische Sachsen | 1577 | 1, p. 346 | 39 | Visitation | L | |
| 171 | Instruktion für die Visitation 1574/1575 | 1574 | 1, p. 352 | 40 | Visitation | L | |
| 172 | Verordnung der Visitatoren im meissnischen Kreise | 1574 | 1, p. 354 | 42 | Visitation | L | |
| 194 | Verordnung des Kurfürsten August auf die Visitationen von 1574, 1575, 1577. Vom 28. Mai | 1578 | 1, p. 356 | 42 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 195 | Pfarr-Wittwen und -Waisen-Ordnung des Consistoriums zu Wittenberg | 1578 | 1, p. 358 | 43 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 205 | Kirchen-Ordnung des Kurfürsten August | 1580 | 1, p. 359 | 44 | Church order | L | |
| 206 | Notarien-Ordnung | 1580 | 1, p. 457 | 45 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.6.5 Freiberg and Wolkenstein (Duke Henry)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 94 | Visitationsinstruktion Herzog Heinrichs für Freiberg. Vom 26. Mai | 1537 | 1, p. 460 | 47 | Visitation | L | |
| 95 | Visitationsartikel des Dr. Jacob Schenk | 1537 | 1, p. 465 | 48 | Visitation | L | |
| 97 | Visitation verordnung zu Freiberg | 1538 | 1, p. 467 | 49 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.6.6 Towns of Ernestine and Albertine Saxony

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 130, Radical Reformation (Müntzer) 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Münzer, Deutsch kirchenampt | n.d. | 1, p. 472 | 50 | Agenda / liturgy | RAD | Thomas Müntzer |
| 13 | Münzer, Deutsch evangelisch messe | 1524 | 1, p. 497 | 51 | Agenda / liturgy | RAD | Thomas Müntzer |
| 14 | Münzer, Ordnung und berechnung des teutschen ampts zu Alstadt | 1524 | 1, p. 504 | 52 | Agenda / liturgy | RAD | Thomas Müntzer |
| 73 | Ordnungen der Visitatoren für Allstedt, a) u. b) | 1533 | 1, p. 507 | 53 | Visitation | L | |
| 159 | Statuta .... einer .... polizei für die stadt Allstedt | 1564 | 1, p. 513 | 54 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 22 | Ordnung des gemeinen kastens zu Altenburg | 1527 | 1, p. 514 | 55 | Poor relief | L | |
| 74 | Verordnung der ceremonien ... für den stift ... zu Aldenburg | 1533 | 1, p. 515 | 56 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 75 | Verordnung der stat Altenburg | 1533 | 1, p. 516 | 56 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 135 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Altenburg | 1554 | 1, p. 518 | 58 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 173 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung von Albrechtshain | 1574 | 1, p. 518 | 58 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 102 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Annaberg | 1539 | 1, p. 520 | 59 | Visitation | L | |
| 142 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Annaberg | 1555 | 1, p. 521 | 60 | Visitation | L | |
| 32 | Ordnung für Baruth | 1529 | 1, p. 524 | 61 | Local order | L | |
| 33 | Ordnung für Belgern | 1529 | 1, p. 525 | 61 | Local order | L | |
| 174 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Beucha | 1574 | 1, p. 525 | 61 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 34 | Ordnung für Belzig | 1529 | 1, p. 527 | 63 | Local order | L | |
| 35 | Generalia für die Dörfer des Amtes Belzig | 1529 | 1, p. 528 | 63 | Visitation | L | |
| 88 | Generalia aller dorfer im amt Belzig | 1534 | 1, p. 529 | 64 | Visitation | L | |
| 36 | Ordnung für die Stadt Bitterfeld | 1529 | 1, p. 530 | 65 | Local order | L | |
| 203 | Ordnung der Hochzeiten und Taufen für die Stadt Belzig | 1579 | 1, p. 530 | 65 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 37 | Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis | 1529 | 1, p. 531 | 66 | Local order | L | |
| 65 | Ordnung für die Stadt Bruck | 1530 | 1, p. 534 | 67 | Local order | L | |
| 175 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Brandis | 1574 | 1, p. 534 | 67 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 89 | Verordnung im closter zum Buch | 1534 | 1, p. 536 | 69 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 122 | Ausschreiben des Herzogs Moritz | 1542 | 1, p. 538 | 69 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 113 | Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren an den pfarrer, rath und gemein zu Kempnitz | 1540 | 1, p. 539 | 70 | Visitation | L | |
| 143 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Chemnitz | 1555 | 1, p. 540 | 71 | Visitation | L | |
| 15 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung der stadt Coburg | 1524 | 1, p. 542 | 72 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 130 | Verordnung und bestellung des kirchendiensts der pfarrn in der stadt Coburg | 1545 | 1, p. 543 | 73 | Appointment / oath | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 144 | Vorschaffung zu Coburg | 1555 | 1, p. 544 | 74 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 38 | Verordnung für die Stadt Colditz | 1529 | 1, p. 545 | 75 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 145 | Visitationsabschied für die Stadt Döbeln | 1555 | 1, p. 547 | 75 | Visitation | L | |
| 196 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Chemnitz 5-G *197. Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Dohna | 1578 | 1, p. 550 | 76 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 39 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Domitzsch | 1529 | 1, p. 551 | 77 | Visitation | L | |
| 103 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Dresden | 1539 | 1, p. 554 | 78 | Visitation | L | |
| 176 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche zu Dresden | 1574 | 1, p. 555 | 78 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 198 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung zu Dresden | 1578 | 1, p. 556 | 79 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 156 | Instruktion für die Verwaltung des gemeinen Kastens in Alt-Dresden | 1558 | 1, p. 557 | 80 | Poor relief | L | |
| 208 | Form der allgemeinen Beichte und Absolution zu Dresden | 1581 | 1, p. 557 | 80 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 40 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Düben | 1529 | 1, p. 559 | 81 | Visitation | L | |
| 41 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Eilenburg | 1529 | 1, p. 560 | 82 | Visitation | L | |
| 158 | Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Eisenberg | 1563 | 1, p. 561 | 83 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 136 | Verordnung der visitatorn für den Superintendenten zu Eisfeld | 1554 | 1, p. 562 | 84 | Visitation | L | |
| 137 | Ordnung der kirchen ceremonien vor die pfarher auf den dorfern bei Eisfeld | 1554 | 1, p. 562 | 84 | Church order | L | |
| 104 | Visitationsartikel für den pfarrer zum Gnandstein | 1539 | 1, p. 564 | 85 | Visitation | L | |
| 114 | Gemeiner bericht der visitatoren ... an den pfarrer und dorfschaft zu Gnandstein | 1540 | 1, p. 564 | 85 | Visitation | L | |
| 187 | Verzeichniss der Kirchen-Ordnung zu Gottleuba | 1577 | 1, p. 567 | 87 | Church order | L | |
| 146 | Artikel durch die herrn visitatores.zu Gotha | 1555 | 1, p. 569 | 88 | Visitation | L | |
| 42 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Grimma | 1529 | 1, p. 571 | 89 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 43 | Generalia aller flecke und dorfer im amte Grimma | 1529 | 1, p. 575 | 90 | Visitation | L | |
| 177 | Ordnung der Predigten und Kinderlehre zu Grossdalzig | 1574 | 1, p. 576 | 90 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 199 | Registratur von der Lokal-Visitation für Hayn | 1578 | 1, p. 577 | 91 | Visitation | L | |
| 44 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Herzberg | 1529 | 1, p. 578 | 92 | Visitation | L | |
| 45 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für das Dorf Altherzberg | 1529 | 1, p. 580 | 92 | Visitation | L | |
| 46 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Jessen | 1529 | 1, p. 581 | 93 | Visitation | L | |
| 165 | Kirchen-Ordnung zu Kapellendorf | 1569 | 1, p. 582 | 94 | Church order | L | |
| 166 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für die Filialen von Kapellendorf | 1569 | 1, p. 583 | 95 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 26 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Kemberg | 1527 | 1, p. 584 | 96 | Visitation | L | |
| 105 | Visitationsartikel für die Klöster zu Leipzig | 1539 | 1, p. 589 | 97 | Visitation | L | |
| 106 | Ordnung für die Klosterjungfrauen zu Leipzig | 1539 | 1, p. 589 | 97 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 107 | Gemeines Fürhalten zu Leipzig | 1539 | 1, p. 590 | 98 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 108 | Verordnungen der Visitatoren zu Leipzig | 1539 | 1, p. 591 | 99 | Visitation | L | |
| 109 | Kirchen-Ordnung einem erbarn rath zu Leipzig zugestelt | 1539 | 1, p. 593 | 100 | Church order | L | |
| | 1567, †160. Gemein Gebet zu Leipzig | 1564 | 1, p. 595 | 101 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 12 | Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens zu Leisnig | 1523 | 1, p. 598 | 102 | Poor relief | L | |
| 47 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Leisnig | 1529 | 1, p. 605 | 103 | Visitation | L | |
| 48 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt zu Leisnig | 1529 | 1, p. 609 | 104 | Visitation | L | |
| 202 | Hochzeits-Ordnung für Leisnig | 1579 | 1, p. 610 | 105 | Marriage | L | |
| 49 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Liebenwerda | 1529 | 1, p. 611 | 106 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 76 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Lieben- . werda | 1533 | 1, p. 613 | 107 | Visitation | L | |
| | 50 Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Lochau | 1529 | 1, p. 614 | 108 | Visitation | L | |
| 77 | Generalia aller dörfer im amt Liebenwerde | 1533 | 1, p. 614 | 108 | Visitation | L | |
| | 51 Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Niemegk | 1529 | 1, p. 615 | 109 | Visitation | L | |
| 52 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Nimbschen | 1529 | 1, p. 616 | 110 | Visitation | L | |
| 78 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Nimbschen | 1533 | 1, p. 618 | 111 | Visitation | L | |
| 79 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Oelsnitz | 1533 | 1, p. 620 | 112 | Visitation | L | |
| 209 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Oelsnitz | 1582 | 1, p. 620 | 112 | Visitation | L | |
| 110 | Verordnung der Visitatoren zu Oschatz | 1539 | 1, p. 622 | 113 | Visitation | L | |
| 115 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Ochatz | 1540 | 1, p. 625 | 114 | Visitation | L | |
| 147 | Abschied, das geistliche einkommen der stadt Oschatz betr | 1555 | 1, p. 627 | 115 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 148 | Visitationsabschied für Oschatz | 1555 | 1, p. 630 | 115 | Visitation | L | |
| 182 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Penig | 1575 | 1, p. 634 | 116 | Church order | L | |
| 111 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Pirna | 1539 | 1, p. 636 | 117 | Visitation | L | |
| 116 | Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatoren für Pirna | 1540 | 1, p. 637 | 118 | Visitation | L | |
| 149 | Abschied der Visitatoren für Pirna | 1555 | 1, p. 638 | 119 | Visitation | L | |
| 6 | Kirchen - Ordnung für die Stadt Pirna, verfasst von Anton Lauterbach | n.d. | 1, p. 641 | 119 | Church order | L | |
| 200 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Pirna | 1578 | 1, p. 645 | 120 | Church order | L | |
| 53 | Ordination der dorfer dem.....closter Plötzke gehörig | 1529 | 1, p. 646 | 121 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 54 | Ordination für Gommern und zugehörige Dorfschaften | 1529 | 1, p. 647 | 122 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 27 | Generalia für Pollerstorf und andere Dörfer im Amt Wittenberg | 1527 | 1, p. 648 | 123 | Visitation | L | |
| 80 | Generalia für Pollerstorf und andere Dörfer im Amt Wittenberg | 1533 | 1, p. 648 | 123 | Visitation | L | |
| 55 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Prettin | 1529 | 1, p. 649 | 124 | Visitation | L | |
| | "81. Ordnung in das junkfrau closter zu Remse | 1533 | 1, p. 651 | 125 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 82 | Ordnung der junkfrauen closter zu Altenburg | 1533 | 1, p. 651 | 125 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 178 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha | 1574 | 1, p. 653 | 125 | Church order | L | |
| 117 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Salza | 1540 | 1, p. 654 | 125 | Church order | L | |
| 118 | Ordnung der visitatorn zu Sangerhausen | 1540 | 1, p. 656 | 127 | Visitation | L | |
| 150 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Sangerhausen | 1555 | 1, p. 657 | 128 | Visitation | L | |
| 188 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung zu Schandau | 1577 | 1, p. 658 | 128 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 56 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben | 1529 | 1, p. 659 | 129 | Church order | L | |
| 57 | Generalia der Pfarren im Amt Schlieben | 1529 | 1, p. 661 | 130 | Visitation | L | |
| 28 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Schmiedeberg | 1527 | 1, p. 662 | 131 | Visitation | L | |
| 58 | Generalia der Dörfer im Amt Schlieben | 1529 | 1, p. 662 | 131 | Visitation | L | |
| 90 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Schneeberg | 1534 | 1, p. 666 | 133 | Visitation | L | |
| 59 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Schönewalde | 1529 | 1, p. 667 | 134 | Church order | L | |
| 183 | Ordnung der predigten und kinderlehr zu Schneeberg | 1575 | 1, p. 667 | 134 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 60 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schweinitz | 1529 | 1, p. 668 | 134 | Church order | L | |
| 29 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Seida | 1527 | 1, p. 670 | 135 | Church order | L | |
| 151 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg | 1555 | 1, p. 671 | 136 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 179 | Ordnung der predigten und kinderlehr zu Gross- Storkwitz | 1574 | 1, p. 673 | 137 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 180 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Taucha | 1574 | 1, p. 674 | 138 | Church order | L | |
| 61 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Torgau | 1529 | 1, p. 675 | 139 | Visitation | L | |
| 91 | Artikel dem rat zu Torgau zugestellt | 1534 | 1, p. 680 | 139 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 184 | Verordnung der Visitatoren zu Torgau | 1575 | 1, p. 682 | 141 | Visitation | L | |
| 62 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Wahrenbrück | 1529 | 1, p. 686 | 142 | Church order | L | |
| 167 | Generalia für die pfarreien der superintendenz Weimar | 1570 | 1, p. 688 | 143 | Visitation | L | |
| 168 | Specialartikel für die Stadt Weimar | 1570 | 1, p. 690 | 144 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 119 | Ordnung der visitacion zu Weissenfels | 1540 | 1, p. 692 | 144 | Local order | L | |
| 201 | Ordnung der geseng, so zu Weissenfels. gehalten wird | 1578 | 1, p. 693 | 145 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Wittenberg (Carlstadt) | 1522 | 1, p. 697 | 146 | Church order | L | Karlstadt's Wittenberg order |
| 16 | Wie es mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt zu Wittenberg | 1525 | 1, p. 698 | 147 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 83 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg | 1533 | 1, p. 700 | 148 | Church order | L | |
| 7 | Bericht über die von Bugenhagen in Wittenberg beobachtete Trauungsordnung | n.d. | 1, p. 710 | 148 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 30 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zahna | 1527 | 1, p. 711 | 149 | Visitation | L | |
| 84 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zahna | 1533 | 1, p. 715 | 150 | Visitation | L | |
| 181 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Zehmen und Rüben | 1574 | 1, p. 717 | 150 | Church order | L | |
| 63 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau | 1529 | 1, p. 721 | 151 | Visitation | L | |
| 64 | Kasten-Ordnung für Zwickau | 1529 | 1, p. 722 | 151 | Poor relief | L | |
| 85 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau | 1533 | 1, p. 723 | 152 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 93 | Vertrag zwischen dem Rath der Stadt Zwickau und den Pfarrern | 1536 | 1, p. 724 | 153 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 131 | Ordnung der pfarren und kirchen zu Zwickau | 1545 | 1, p. 725 | 154 | Local order | L | |
| 154 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Zwickau | 1556 | 1, p. 726 | 155 | Visitation | L | |
| 207 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Zwickau | 1580 | 1, p. 727 | 156 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

## 1.7 Volume 2: Saxony and Thuringia II: bishoprics, counties, Henneberg, Magdeburg, Anhalt

151 texts.

### 1.7.1 Bishoprics of Merseburg, Meissen, Naumburg-Zeitz and Wurzen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 44 | Ordinations-Ordnung. Entwurf | 1545 | 2, p. 6 | 1210 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 46 | Bestellung des Consistoriums zu Merseburg | 1545 | 2, p. 9 | 1210 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Visitations-Ordnung im Stifte Merseburg | 1544 | 2, p. 10 | 1210 | Visitation | L | |
| 43 | Merseburger Synodalunterricht | 1543 | 2, p. 12 | 1211 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 47 | Kursächsische Superintendenten-Instruktion | 1545 | 2, p. 12 | 1211 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 48 | Merseburger Synodal-Vorhaltung | 1545 | 2, p. 25 | 1212 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 49 | Merseburger Artikel | 1545 | 2, p. 27 | 1213 | Other | L | |
| 60 | Einfältiger unterricht von verbotenen personen und graden u. s. w. in Merseburg | 1548 | 2, p. 28 | 1213 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 45 | Ordinations-Ordnung | 1545 | 2, p. 36 | 1213 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 1 | Form der öffentlichen Busse für das Bisthum Merseburg | n.d. | 2, p. 38 | 1213 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 51 | Ehe-Ordnung des Consistoriums zu Meissen | 1545 | 2, p. 48 | 1214 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 52 | Consistorial-Ordnung für Meissen | 1545 | 2, p. 49 | 1214 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 61 | Verordnung des Herzogs Moritz an das Consistorium zu Meissen | 1548 | 2, p. 50 | 1215 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Ordnung der Predigerunterstützungs -, Pfarrwittwen- und -Waisenkasse für die Superintendenz Meissen | 1570 | 2, p. 50 | 1215 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 28 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen | 1540 | 2, p. 52 | 1216 | Visitation | L | |
| 12 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche in Naumburg | 1527 | 2, p. 59 | 1218 | Church order | L | |
| 26 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche zu Naumburg | 1537 | 2, p. 61 | 1219 | Church order | L | |
| 50 | Kirchen-Ordnung des Bischofs von Naumburg- Zeitz | 1545 | 2, p. 89 | 1219 | Church order | L | |
| 32 | Kasten-Ordnung für Wurzen | 1542 | 2, p. 93 | 1221 | Poor relief | L | |
| 33 | Gemeine Artikel für Wurzen | 1542 | 2, p. 94 | 1222 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| | Artikul, worauf die pfarhern und custodes antworten sollen (Wurzen) | 1578 | 2, p. 99 | 1224 | Articles / statutes | L | |

#### 1.7.2 Amt Stolpen and Bischofswerda

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 79 | Visitations-Rezess für die Stadt Bischofswerda | 1559 | 2, p. 104 | 1226 | Visitation | L | |
| 80 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für die Stadt Bischofswerda | 1559 | 2, p. 106 | 1226 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.7.3 Lordship and town of Plauen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | Ordnung der Ceremonien zu Plauen | 1529 | 2, p. 110 | 1227 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 15 | Die von Hausmann für Dessau verfasste Ordnung 16. Visitations-Verordnung für Plauen | 1532 | 2, p. 111 | 1227 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.7.4 Lordship of Ronneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Ronneburg | 1529 | 2, p. 115 | 1228 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.7.5 Schwarzburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 142 | Visitations-Abschied für Schwarzburg | 1587 | 2, p. 127 | 1230 | Visitation | L | |
| 17 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Schwarzburgische Oberherrschaft | 1532 | 2, p. 128 | 1230 | Visitation | L | |
| 18 | Visitations-Artikel für das Amt Arnstadt | 1532 | 2, p. 128 | 1230 | Visitation | L | |
| 63 | Ordnung der religion, wie es in grafschaften Schwarzburg und Stolberg soll gehalten werden | 1549 | 2, p. 129 | 1230 | Local order | L | |
| | Form und mass der visitation im amt Rudolstadt | 1575 | 2, p. 130 | 1230 | Visitation | L | |
| | Ordo lectionum scholae nostrae Rudolstadiensis | 1575 | 2, p. 131 | 1230 | School / university | L | |
| | Gräflich Schwarzburgische Kirchen-Ordnung | 1574 | 2, p. 132 | 1230 | Church order | L | |
| 143 | Ordnung der Fest- und Feiertage für Schwarzburg | 1587 | 2, p. 137 | 1230 | Discipline / police | L | |

### 1.7.6 Reuss

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Rath der Stadt Schleiz | 1532 | 2, p. 143 | 1234 | Visitation | L | |
| 22 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster Saalburg | 1532 | 2, p. 143 | 1234 | Visitation | L | |
| 19 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Hauptmann zu Gera | 1532 | 2, p. 149 | 1234 | Visitation | L | |
| 20 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für den Rath der Stadt Gera | 1532 | 2, p. 150 | 1234 | Visitation | L | |
| 24 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Gera | 1534 | 2, p. 151 | 1234 | Visitation | L | |
| 38 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Lobenstein | 1543 | 2, p. 152 | 1234 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 67 | Kirchen-Ordnung Heinrich's IV. von Reuss | 1552 | 2, p. 153 | 1234 | Church order | L | |
| 81 | Mandat und Consistorial-Ordnung für Mansfeld *82. Kirchen-Ordnung für die pfarrer der superintendenz Gera | 1560 | 2, p. 158 | 1234 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.7.7 Schönburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 136 | Schönburg'scher Hausvertrag | 1582 | 2, p. 166 | 1235 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 34 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Schönburg'schen Gebiete | 1542 | 2, p. 167 | 1235 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.7.8 Harz counties (Mansfeld, Stolberg, Hohenstein, Regenstein, Quedlinburg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 118 | Ankündigung der Visitation für das Amt Leinungen | 1570 | 2, p. 182 | 1238 | Visitation | L | |
| 119 | Ankündigung der Visitation für das Amt Rammelburg | 1570 | 2, p. 182 | 1238 | Visitation | L | |
| 58 | Vertrag zwischen den Grafen von Mansfeld, vermittelt durch Luther und Jonas | 1546 | 2, p. 187 | 1240 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 68 | Form und weise einer visitation für die grafschaft Mansfeld. (Sarcerius) | 1554 | 2, p. 190 | 1240 | Visitation | L | |
| 141 | Mansfeldische geistliche Consistorial-Ordnung | 1586 | 2, p. 197 | 1240 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Kirchen-Agende für die Grafschaft Mansfeld | 1580 | 2, p. 215 | 1241 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Statut der Stadt Stolberg a./Harz | n.d. | 2, p. 250 | 1242 | Other | L | |
| 3 | Kirchen-Ordnung für das Gericht Wintzingerode oder Bodenstein | n.d. | 2, p. 252 | 1243 | Church order | L | |
| 29 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Quedlinburg | 1540 | 2, p. 262 | 1244 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.7.9 County of Henneberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 53 | Mandat Wilhelm's von Henneberg | 1545 | 2, p. 283 | 1247 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 54 | Mandat des Grafen Georg Ernst von Henneberg | 1545 | 2, p. 284 | 1247 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Mandat Georg Ernst's zu Henneberg | 1574 | 2, p. 285 | 1247 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung für Henneberg | 1574 | 2, p. 286 | 1247 | Visitation | L | |
| 137 | Kirchen-Ordnung Georg Ernst's von Henneberg | 1582 | 2, p. 298 | 1247 | Church order | L | |
| 153 | Bericht über die Bestellung und die Thätigkeit des Consistoriums zu Henneberg | 1635 | 2, p. 325 | 1247 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 72 | Instruktion für die Visitatoren von Henneberg- Römhild | 1556 | 2, p. 326 | 1247 | Visitation | L | |
| 73 | Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild | 1556 | 2, p. 328 | 1247 | Visitation | L | |
| 103 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Belrieth und Einhausen | 1566 | 2, p. 329 | 1248 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 104 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Dingsleben | 1566 | 2, p. 331 | 1248 | Church order | L | |
| 105 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Goldlauter | 1566 | 2, p. 332 | 1248 | Church order | L | |
| 106 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Herpf | 1566 | 2, p. 334 | 1248 | Church order | L | |
| 107 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Marisfeld | 1566 | 2, p. 337 | 1248 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 85 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Meiningen | 1562 | 2, p. 339 | 1248 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 108 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Meiningen | 1566 | 2, p. 339 | 1248 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 94 | Vertrag zwischen der Hauptpfarrei Niederlauer und der Nebenpfarrei Harte | 1563 | 2, p. 341 | 1249 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 109 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Niederlauer | 1566 | 2, p. 341 | 1249 | Church order | L | |
| 110 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Obermaassfeld | 1566 | 2, p. 342 | 1249 | Church order | L | |
| 111 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Queienfeld | 1566 | 2, p. 344 | 1249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 86 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Ritschenhausen | 1562 | 2, p. 345 | 1249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 112 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Ritschenhausen | 1566 | 2, p. 346 | 1249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 71 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Schmalkalden | 1555 | 2, p. 347 | 1249 | Visitation | L | |
| 87 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Schmalkalden | 1562 | 2, p. 349 | 1249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 88 | Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen in der kirchen zu Suhl | 1562 | 2, p. 350 | 1250 | Local order | L | |
| 113 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Sulzfeld und Klein- Bardorf | 1566 | 2, p. 352 | 1250 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 89 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Vachdorf | 1562 | 2, p. 354 | 1250 | Church order | L | |
| 114 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Wasungen | 1566 | 2, p. 355 | 1250 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.7.10 Mainz possessions (Eichsfeld, Erfurt, Querfurt)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 75 | Formula visitationis ecclesiae Erfurtensis | 1557 | 2, p. 365 | 1251 | Visitation | L | |
| | Formula pacificationis zu Erfurt | 1580 | 2, p. 366 | 1251 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 139 | Policei-Ordnung für Erfurt | 1583 | 2, p. 370 | 1251 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 11 | Deutsches Kirchenamt (Erfurt) | 1525 | 2, p. 375 | 1251 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.7.11 Imperial cities of Mühlhausen and Nordhausen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Instruktion für den Superintendenten zu Mühlberg | 1571 | 2, p. 385 | 1253 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 30 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Dörfer der Stadt Mühlhausen und die Vogtei | 1541 | 2, p. 388 | 1253 | Church order | L | |
| 35 | Kirchen-Ordnung für die Dörfer der Stadt Mühlhausen | 1542 | 2, p. 389 | 1253 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 36 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Mühlhausen | 1542 | 2, p. 389 | 1253 | Church order | L | |
| 76 | Artikel der Leipziger Predikanten für Mühlhausen | 1557 | 2, p. 394 | 1254 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 64 | Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen | 1549 | 2, p. 396 | 1254 | Discipline / police | L | |

#### 1.7.12 Archbishopric of Magdeburg and Bishopric of Halberstadt

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 96 | Verzeichniss der in der Visitation des Erzstifts Magdeburg aufgefundenen Mängel | 1564 | 2, p. 403 | 1256 | Visitation | L | |
| 90 | Visitations-Instruktion für Magdeburg | 1562 | 2, p. 407 | 1256 | Visitation | L | |
| 91 | Mandat Erzbischofs Sigismund von Magdeburg, betr. die Kirchendisciplin | 1562 | 2, p. 411 | 1256 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Consistorial-Ordnung für das Erzstift Magdeburg | 1580 | 2, p. 414 | 1256 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 140 | Visitations-Instruktion für das Erzstift Magdeburg | 1583 | 2, p. 418 | 1256 | Visitation | L | |
| 37 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Burg | 1542 | 2, p. 427 | 1257 | Church order | L | |
| 95 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung für Hadmersleben | 1563 | 2, p. 428 | 1257 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 39 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Gemeinde zu Halle | 1543 | 2, p. 434 | 1257 | Church order | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung der christlichen gemein zu Halle | 1573 | 2, p. 436 | 1257 | Church order | L | |
| 92 | Form der öffentlichen Busse zu Jüterbogk | 1562 | 2, p. 443 | 1257 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9 | Reformations-Artikel für Magdeburg | 1524 | 2, p. 448 | 1257 | Church order | L | |
| 10 | Ordnung der gemeinen kesten .... in der löblichen stadt Maydeburg | 1524 | 2, p. 449 | 1257 | Local order | L | |
| 69 | Etliche artikel zu notwendiger kirchenordnung gehörig, welcher sich die pfarrherr . zu Magdeburg.vereiniget u. s. w | 1554 | 2, p. 450 | 1257 | Church order | L | |
| 117 | Ordnung vom kirchengericht, bann, auch beruf und enturlaubung der prediger in Magdeburg | 1569 | 2, p. 453 | 1257 | Local order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 83 | Bestallungsurkunde für den Superintendenten in Magdeburg | 1560 | 2, p. 454 | 1257 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 97 | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Neuhaldensleben | 1564 | 2, p. 456 | 1257 | Visitation | L | |
| 98 | Ordo ceremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis | 1564 | 2, p. 457 | 1257 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Ordnung zu Querfurt, Vom leben und wandel der pfarherrn, kirchen- und schuldiener | n.d. | 2, p. 461 | 1257 | School / university | L | |
| 99 | Ordnung der Visitatoren für Stassfurt | 1564 | 2, p. 462 | 1258 | Visitation | L | |
| 145 | Visitations-Instruktion für das Bisthum Halberstadt | 1588 | 2, p. 466 | 1259 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Christliche artikul und bericht, wie es in der kirchen zu Aschersleben. sol gehalten werden | n.d. | 2, p. 473 | 1260 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Kirchen agenda, derer sich der rath mit dem ministerio verglichen (Aschersleben) | 1575 | 2, p. 477 | 1260 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 74 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Cochstedt | 1556 | 2, p. 483 | 1260 | Church order | L | |
| 147 | Kirchen-Ordnung zu Croppenstedt | 1589 | 2, p. 484 | 1260 | Church order | L | |
| 100 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Stadt Ermsleben | 1564 | 2, p. 485 | 1260 | Church order | L | |
| 101 | Verzeichniss, wie den hern pfarhern in St. Johannis das pfaramt bevohlen wird (Stadt Halberstadt) | 1564 | 2, p. 486 | 1260 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 40 | Altarmanns-Ordnung für die Johanniskirche der Stadt Halberstadt | 1543 | 2, p. 487 | 1260 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Ordnung, so die pfarvorwanten zu St. Johannis zu erhaltung der rechten armen .... vorgeschlagen (Stadt Halberstadt) | n.d. | 2, p. 489 | 1260 | Poor relief | L | |

#### 1.7.13 Principality of Anhalt

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1590; Reformed from 1596.
- **Note**: Lutheran until Prince Johann Georg's reforms: exorcism dropped 1589/90, Reformed usages from 1596, formal Reformed confession 1606.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 27, Reformed 3, Philippist 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 148 | Reskript von Hans Georg von Anhalt | 1590 | 2, p. 531 | 1261 | Mandate / decree | PH | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 151 | Ausschreiben von Hans Georg von Anhalt | 1599 | 2, p. 535 | 1261 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 27 | Die von Jonas für Zerbst verfasste Ordnung | 1538 | 2, p. 544 | 1262 | Other | L | |
| 31 | Ausschreiben der Fürsten Wolfgang, Johann, Georg und Joachim von Anhalt | 1541 | 2, p. 547 | 1262 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 55 | Vollmacht für die Visitation in Anhalt | 1545 | 2, p. 549 | 1262 | Visitation | L | |
| 56 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Fürsten Johann, Georg und Joachim von Anhalt | 1545 | 2, p. 549 | 1262 | Church order | L | |
| 59 | Ausschreiben Johann Georg's und Joachim's von Anhalt, betr. allgemeine Landesbusse | 1546 | 2, p. 553 | 1262 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 62 | Kirchen-Ordnung der Fürsten Johann und Georg von Anhalt | 1548 | 2, p. 554 | 1262 | Church order | L | |
| 65 | Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge in Anhalt | 1551 | 2, p. 555 | 1262 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 70 | Verordnung des Fürsten Joachim von Anhalt, betr. Einführung von Synoden | 1554 | 2, p. 557 | 1262 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 77 | Instruktion zur Visitation des Amtsbezirks Dessau | 1557 | 2, p. 557 | 1262 | Visitation | L | |
| 84 | Vollmacht und Instruktion zur Visitation für Anhalt | 1560 | 2, p. 559 | 1262 | Visitation | L | |
| 93 | Kirchen-Ordnung auf dem Lande in Anhalt | 1562 | 2, p. 561 | 1262 | Church order | L | |
| 115 | Bericht des Anhalter Superintendenten Fabricius über seine Amtsführung | 1567 | 2, p. 564 | 1262 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7 | Verdracht unser g. f. und herrn und des ehrbarn rats zu Cervest der ehleute haben | n.d. | 2, p. 567 | 1262 | Marriage | L | between 1545 and 1570 (editor): addressed to Superintendent Fabricius |
| 102 | Fürstlicher bevehl der kirchenlehn, stipendiaten und des examens halben in Anhalt | 1565 | 2, p. 567 | 1262 | School / university | L | |
| 116 | Kirchen-Ordnung des Fürsten Bernhard von Anhalt | 1568 | 2, p. 568 | 1262 | Church order | L | |
| | Polizei- und Landes-Ordnung für Anhalt | 1572 | 2, p. 570 | 1262 | Discipline / police | L | |
| | Privilegium, belangende der verstorbenen pastorum | 1580 | 2, p. 574 | 1262 | Poor relief | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | vorlassene witwen | | | | | | |
| 138 | Visitations-Instruktion für Anhalt | 1582 | 2, p. 574 | 1262 | Visitation | L | |
| 144 | Visitations-Instruktion für Anhalt | 1587 | 2, p. 577 | 1262 | Visitation | L | |
| 146 | Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis für Anhalt | 1588 | 2, p. 578 | 1262 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 149 | Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten | 1594 | 2, p. 579 | 1262 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 150 | Verordnung von Johann Georg von Anhalt | 1596 | 2, p. 580 | 1262 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 152 | Kirchen-Ordnung für Anhalt | 1599 | 2, p. 581 | 1262 | Church order | R | |
| 23 | Bericht von Schlaginhaufen über die von ihm in Cöthen beobachtete Gottesdienst-Ordnung | 1532 | 2, p. 582 | 1263 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 25 | Kirchen-Ordnung zu Harzgerode | 1534 | 2, p. 586 | 1263 | Church order | L | |
| | Vergleich zwischen rath und superintendenten zu Zerbst | 1572 | 2, p. 590 | 1263 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 66 | Verdracht-Artikel zwischen uns kirchendiener zu Zervest | 1551 | 2, p. 591 | 1263 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 78 | Vergleich zwischen den Kirchendienern zu Zerbst | 1558 | 2, p. 592 | 1263 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 57 | Vereinbarungen des Ministeriums zu Zerbst untereinander und mit dem Rathe zu Zerbst | 1545 | 2, p. 593 | 1263 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Ordnung, wie es mit dem gottesdienst in der kirchen gehalten wird zu Gerenrode | 1541 | 2, p. 595 | 1264 | Agenda / liturgy | L | dated by the editor: the order Abbess Anna sent to Prince George on 23 July 1541 |

#### 1.7.14 Naumburg cathedral (supplement)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 41 | Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche zu Naumburg | 1543 | 2, p. 596 | 1265 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

## 1.8 Volume 3: Brandenburg, Lusatia, Silesia

117 texts.

### 1.8.1 Electorate of Brandenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Joachim II's order of 1540 kept much traditional ceremonial; the Interim was imposed in 1548, but Sehling prints no Interim order.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 118 | Rezess für die Stadt Frankfurt | 1600 | 3, p. 22 | 1744 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 11 | Neumärkische Kastenordnung | 1540 | 3, p. 28 | 1745 | Poor relief | L | |
| 43 | Des Markgrafen Johann Anweisung zur Kirchenvisitation in der Neumark | 1551 | 3, p. 36 | 1745 | Visitation | L | |
| 12 | Kirchenordnung der Mark Brandenburg | 1540 | 3, p. 39 | 1746 | Church order | L | |
| 53 | Ordnung und Satzung, wornach sich die patronen usw. in Brandenburg zu richten | 1558 | 3, p. 90 | 1747 | Local order | L | |
| 71 | Brandenburgische Kirchenordnung | 1572 | 3, p. 94 | 1747 | Church order | L | |
| 74 | Brandenburgische Visitations- und Consistorialordnung | 1573 | 3, p. 105 | 1748 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.8.2 Lordships of Beeskow and Storkow

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 100 | Mandat, betr. Einführung des Gnadenjahrs für das Domstift Cöln | 1585 | 3, p. 142 | 1749 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 75 | Kirchenordnung der Markgräfin Catharina | 1573 | 3, p. 147 | 1750 | Church order | L | |
| 85 | Abschied für Beeskow | 1570 | 3, p. 147 | 1750 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.8.3 Lands of the von der Schulenburg family

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 72 | Kirchenordnung der Familie v. d. Schulenburg | 1572 | 3, p. 149 | 1752 | Church order | L | |

### 1.8.4 Towns of the Mark Brandenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 49 | Visitations-Abschied für Angermünde | 1557 | 3, p. 151 | 1753 | Visitation | L | |
| 48 | Visitations-Abschied für Bagow | 1553 | 3, p. 153 | 1754 | Visitation | L | |
| 13 | Visitations-Abschied für die Kirchen St. Nicolai und St. Marien zu Berlin | 1540 | 3, p. 155 | 1755 | Visitation | L | |
| 44 | Visitations-Abschied für Berlin | 1551 | 3, p. 160 | 1756 | Visitation | L | |
| 76 | Visitationsabschied für Berlin | 1574 | 3, p. 161 | 1757 | Visitation | L | |
| 19 | Visitations-Rezess für die Altstadt Brandenburg | 1540 | 3, p. 178 | 1758 | Visitation | L | |
| 80 | Abschied für Altstadt Brandenburg | 1575 | 3, p. 182 | 1758 | Visitation | L | |
| 81 | Abschied für Neustadt Brandenburg | 1575 | 3, p. 182 | 1758 | Visitation | L | |
| 14 | Visitations-Abschied für Cöln | 1540 | 3, p. 194 | 1759 | Visitation | L | |
| 20 | Visitations-Abschied für Cöpenik | 1540 | 3, p. 198 | 1760 | Visitation | L | |
| 86 | Visitationsabschied für Cottbus | 1570 | 3, p. 200 | 1761 | Visitation | L | |
| 21 | Visitations-Rezess für das Benediktiner-Nonnen- Kloster Crevese | 1540 | 3, p. 202 | 1762 | Visitation | L | |
| 45 | Anordnungen der Visitatoren wegen der Pfarre zu Crevese | 1551 | 3, p. 204 | 1763 | Visitation | L | |
| 15 | Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Frankfurt | 1540 | 3, p. 208 | 1764 | Church order | L | |
| 70 | Agenda, colligirt und zusammengetragen durch Dr. Joachimum Goltzium | 1560 | 3, p. 213 | 1765 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 22 | Abschied für Gardelegen | 1540 | 3, p. 218 | 1766 | Visitation | L | |
| 108 | Distributio concionum für Gardelegen | 1590 | 3, p. 222 | 1767 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 87 | Constitutiones inspectoris ministrorum et pastorum villanorum in sede Garleviana | 1570 | 3, p. 224 | 1768 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 88 | Visitationsordnung für Gardelegen | 1570 | 3, p. 226 | 1768 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | Abschied der Visitatoren für Havelberg | 1545 | 3, p. 227 | 1768 | Visitation | L | |
| | / *54. Visitationsordnung für Havelberg | 1558 | 3, p. 229 | 1769 | Visitation | L | |
| | I *55. Abschied für das Dorf Kleptow | 1558 | 3, p. 235 | 1770 | Visitation | L | |
| 103 | Gottesdienstordnung für Königsberg in der Neumark | 1586 | 3, p. 236 | 1771 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 23 | Abschied für das Kloster Lehnin | 1540 | 3, p. 238 | 1772 | Visitation | L | |
| 56 | Abschied für Lenzen | 1558 | 3, p. 239 | 1773 | Visitation | L | |
| 24 | Abschied für Lychen | 1540 | 3, p. 240 | 1773 | Visitation | L | |
| 25 | Abschied für Osterburg | 1540 | 3, p. 242 | 1773 | Visitation | L | |
| 34 | Visitationsordnung der Stadt Perleberg | 1542 | 3, p. 244 | 1774 | Visitation | L | |
| 57 | Ordnung der Stadt Perleberg | 1558 | 3, p. 249 | 1774 | Local order | L | |
| 92 | Abschied für Perleberg | 1581 | 3, p. 253 | 1774 | Visitation | L | |
| 26 | Abschied für Potsdam | 1540 | 3, p. 257 | 1775 | Visitation | L | |
| 50 | Abschied für Prenzlau | 1557 | 3, p. 261 | 1776 | Visitation | L | |
| 95 | Vergleich der Geistlichen zu Prenzlau | 1582 | 3, p. 262 | 1777 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 96 | Ermahnung zum Opfer tür die Kirchendiener zu Prenzlau | 1582 | 3, p. 262 | 1777 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 97 | Hospitalordnung zu Prenzlau | 1582 | 3, p. 263 | 1777 | Poor relief | L | |
| 58 | Abschied für Neu-Ruppin | 1558 | 3, p. 264 | 1778 | Visitation | L | |
| 27 | Abschied für Salzwedel-Altstadt | 1540 | 3, p. 266 | 1778 | Visitation | L | |
| 28 | Abschied für das Kloster St. Annen zu Salzwedel- Altstadt | 1540 | 3, p. 272 | 1779 | Visitation | L | |
| 89 | Abschied der Altstadt Salzwedel | 1570 | 3, p. 272 | 1779 | Treaty / agreement | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 29 | Abschied für Salzwedel-Neustadt | 1540 | 3, p. 286 | 1779 | Visitation | L | |
| 90 | Abschied der Neustadt Salzwedel | 1570 | 3, p. 289 | 1780 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 106 | Bestellung des ev. Superintendenten in Friedland 107. Begräbnissordnung für Sommerfeld | 1588 | 3, p. 301 | 1781 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 30 | Abschied für die Pfarrkirche zu Spandau | 1540 | 3, p. 303 | 1782 | Visitation | L | |
| 31 | Visitations-Abschied für das Kloster zu Spandau | 1540 | 3, p. 305 | 1783 | Visitation | L | |
| 16 | Visitations-Abschied für Domstift und Domkirche zu Stendal | 1540 | 3, p. 307 | 1784 | Visitation | L | |
| 17 | Verordnung und Bestellung aller pfarrkirchen usw. der Stadt Stendal | 1540 | 3, p. 309 | 1784 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 32 | Öffentliches Kirchengebet für den Reichstag zu Regensburg | 1540 | 3, p. 314 | 1785 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 46 | Visitations-Abschied für Stendal | 1551 | 3, p. 315 | 1786 | Visitation | L | |
| 84 | Abschied für Stendal | 1578 | 3, p. 317 | 1787 | Visitation | L | |
| 77 | Visitationsabschied für Strausberg | 1574 | 3, p. 332 | 1787 | Visitation | L | |
| 33 | Ordnung für Tangermünde | 1540 | 3, p. 334 | 1788 | Local order | L | |
| 91 | Constitutiones sen decreta inspectoris ministrorum et pastorum paganorum in sede Tangermundensi | 1580 | 3, p. 336 | 1788 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 119 | Ritus in ecclesia Tangermundensi plerique pene diu observati | 1603 | 3, p. 338 | 1788 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | / *47. Visitations-Abschied für Werben | 1551 | 3, p. 341 | 1789 | Visitation | L | |
| 78 | Abschied für das Dorf Wartenberg | 1574 | 3, p. 341 | 1789 | Visitation | L | |
| 93 | Abschied für Werben | 1581 | 3, p. 344 | 1790 | Visitation | L | |
| 59 | Abschied für Wusterhausen | 1558 | 3, p. 352 | 1790 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.8.5 Upper and Lower Lusatia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ausschreiben des Landvogts der Niederlausitz | n.d. | 3, p. 362 | 1791 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 111 | Kirchenordnung des Landvogts Jaroslaw von Kolowradt, für die Niederlausitz | 1592 | 3, p. 363 | 1792 | Church order | L | |
| 35 | Kirchenordnung des Joachim von Bieberstein | 1542 | 3, p. 366 | 1793 | Church order | L | |
| 104 | Verordnung der Herren Johann und Abraham von Bieberstein | 1587 | 3, p. 368 | 1794 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 79 | Kirchenordnung des Joachim v. d. Schulenburg für die Herrschaft Lübbenau | 1574 | 3, p. 370 | 1795 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Gutachten Luthers über die Ordnung des Hans von Minkwitz für Sonnenfelde | 1525 | 3, p. 371 | 1795 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 116 | Kirchenordnung für die Herrschaften Sorau und Triebei | 1595 | 3, p. 371 | 1795 | Church order | L | |
| 8 | Ordnung des Raths für die Altaristen zu Görlitz | 1530 | 3, p. 375 | 1796 | Local order | L | |
| 67 | Stadt-Statuten von Görlitz | 1565 | 3, p. 376 | 1796 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 94 | Ordnungsartikel der Stadt Löbau | 1581 | 3, p. 377 | 1797 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 66 | Kirchenordnung für Zittau | 1564 | 3, p. 379 | 1798 | Church order | L | |
| 117 | Kirchenordnung für Herwigsdorf bei Zittau | 1595 | 3, p. 379 | 1798 | Church order | L | |
| 36 | Verordnung wegen Feier des Michaelstages für Cottbus | 1542 | 3, p. 383 | 1799 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 60 | Eheordnung für Cottbus | 1558 | 3, p. 384 | 1799 | Marriage | L | |

#### 1.8.6 Silesia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | 152S. 7. Schul- und Kirchenordnung des Raths der Stadt Breslau | 1527 | 3, p. 396 | 1803 | Church order | L | |
| | 41 Gottesdienstordnung für Breslau | 1550 | 3, p. 400 | 1804 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 42 | Ehestatut für Breslau, um 1550 | 1550 | 3, p. 404 | 1807 | Marriage | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 51 | Bericht über die in Breslau bestehende Ordnung | 1557 | 3, p. 404 | 1807 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 101 | Seuchegebet für Breslau | 1585 | 3, p. 405 | 1807 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Bettelordnung für Breslau | 1521 | 3, p. 406 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 3 | Gotteskastenordnung für Breslau | 1528 | 3, p. 406 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 105 | Gebet für die Wahl eines polnischen Königs | 1587 | 3, p. 406 | 1807 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Instruktion und Ordnung des gemeinen Almosen zu Breslau | 1526 | 3, p. 409 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 73 | Ordnung der Bettler für Breslau | 1572 | 3, p. 411 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 108 | Breslauische Bettlerordnung | 1591 | 3, p. 414 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 18 | Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Neumarkt. Nach 1540 | 1540 | 3, p. 417 | 1807 | Church order | L | |
| 102 | Almosenordnung der Stadt Breslau | 1585 | 3, p. 418 | 1807 | Poor relief | L | |
| 37 | Visitationsbefehl für Liegnitz | 1542 | 3, p. 421 | 1808 | Visitation | L | |
| 10 | Verordnung des Herzogs Friedrich für die Stadt Liegnitz | 1535 | 3, p. 429 | 1809 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 6 | Des . . . fursten und herrn, Friedrichs . . . zur Liegnitz . . . Grund, ursach, und entschuldigung | 1527 | 3, p. 430 | 1809 | School / university | L | |
| 9 | Vergleichung des Ausschusses und folgend aller diener des hl. evangelii der Liegnitz- und Brigischen Fürstenthümer | 1535 | 3, p. 436 | 1809 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 38 | Kirchenordnung für Liegnitz-Brieg | 1542 | 3, p. 439 | 1809 | Church order | L | |
| 39 | Visitations-Instruktion für Brieg | 1542 | 3, p. 441 | 1809 | Visitation | L | |
| 52 | Mandat Georgs II. für Liegnitz-Brieg | 1557 | 3, p. 442 | 1809 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 68 | Visitations-Instruktion für Liegnitz-Brieg | 1565 | 3, p. 443 | 1809 | Visitation | L | |
| 61 | Geschäftsordnung für den Generalkonvent in Liegnitz-Brieg. Nach 1557 | 1558 | 3, p. 444 | 1809 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 69 | Verordnung wegen des Türkengebets zu Brieg | 1565 | 3, p. 444 | 1809 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 112 | Kirchenordnung Herzog Joachim Friedrichs zu Liegnitz und Brieg | 1592 | 3, p. 444 | 1809 | Church order | L | |
| | f63. Traubüchlein von Georg Buchholtzer. 64. Eheordnung für das Fürstenthum Jägerndorf | 1561 | 3, p. 450 | 1810 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 82 | Berufungsurkunde für den Dechanten zu Pless | 1577 | 3, p. 454 | 1812 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 113 | Kirchenordnung der Standesherren Seifried und Abraham von Promnitz für Pless | 1592 | 3, p. 455 | 1813 | Church order | L | |
| 98 | Kirchenordnung für das Fürstenthum Teschen | 1584 | 3, p. 458 | 1814 | Church order | L | |
| 62 | Instruktion für den Organisten zu Münsterberg | 1558 | 3, p. 466 | 1816 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 83 | Bestätigung der an der Pfarrkirche bestehenden Bruderschaft des Bürgerchors zu Münsterberg | 1577 | 3, p. 466 | 1816 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 114 | Zucht- und Polizeiordnung für Hirschberg | 1592 | 3, p. 470 | 1819 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 65 | Begräbnissordnung für Habelschwerdt | 1563 | 3, p. 474 | 1821 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 99 | Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal und Goldstein | 1584 | 3, p. 476 | 1823 | Church order | L | |
| 110 | Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal und Goldstein | 1590 | 3, p. 477 | 1824 | Church order | L | |
| 115 | Kirchenordnung der Herrschaften Freudenthal, und Goldstein | 1592 | 3, p. 481 | 1824 | Church order | L | |

## 1.9 Volume 4: Prussia, Poland, Pomerania

126 texts.

### 1.9.1 Duchy of Prussia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Visitations-Abschied für Fischhausen (Regest) | 1568 | 4, p. 11 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Tromnau (Regest) | 1576 | 4, p. 14 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Grampten (Regest) | 1576 | 4, p. 14 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Visitations-Abschied für Krepelnau (Regest) | 1577 | 4, p. 14 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Marienfeld (Regest) | 1578 | 4, p. 15 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Mühlhausen (Regest) | 1578 | 4, p. 15 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Döbern (Regest) | 1578 | 4, p. 15 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied für Hohenstein (Regest) | 1578 | 4, p. 15 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Abschied in Preussen (Regest) | 1584 | 4, p. 17 | 1830 | Visitation | L | |
| 1 | Themata episcopi Risenburgensis | 1525 | 4, p. 29 | 1831 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 2 | Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung in Preussen | 1525 | 4, p. 30 | 1832 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 3 | Etliche ausgezogen artikel aus gemeiner landsordnung des herzogthums Preussen | 1525 | 4, p. 38 | 1833 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Visitations-Instruktion für Preussen | 1526 | 4, p. 41 | 1833 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Visitations-Instruktion für Preussen | 1528 | 4, p. 42 | 1833 | Visitation | L | |
| 6 | Episcopale mandatum für Preussen | 1539 | 4, p. 45 | 1833 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Artikel von erwelung und underhaltung der pfarrer u. s. w. in Preussen | 1540 | 4, p. 47 | 1833 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 8 | Artikel durch fürstliche durchleuchtigkeit u. s. w. bewilliget | 1540 | 4, p. 53 | 1833 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 9 | Verordnung gegen abergläubische Missbrauche | 1541 | 4, p. 56 | 1833 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 10a | Bevelch zur gottesforcht u. s. w. in Preussen | 1543 | 4, p. 57 | 1833 | Other | L | |
| 10b | Rundschreiben zur Vollziehung des vorstehenden Befehls | 1543 | 4, p. 60 | 1833 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Eides- und Ordinations-Formulare in Preussen | 1543 | 4, p. 61 | 1833 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 12 | Ordnung vom Gottesdienst in Preussen | 1544 | 4, p. 61 | 1833 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 13 | Kirchenordnung in Preussen | 1568 | 4, p. 72 | 1833 | Church order | L | |
| 14 | Von erwehlung der beiden bischoff in Preussen | 1568 | 4, p. 107 | 1833 | Other | L | |
| 15 | Kirchenzucht-Mandat für Preussen | 1581 | 4, p. 122 | 1833 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 16 | Consistorialordnung in Preussen | 1584 | 4, p. 123 | 1834 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 17 | Visitations-Abschied von Czichen | 1581 | 4, p. 139 | 1836 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | Visitations-Abschied für die Stadt Holland | 1578 | 4, p. 140 | 1836 | Visitation | L | |
| 19 | Kastenordnung von Königsberg | 1524 | 4, p. 143 | 1836 | Poor relief | L | |
| 20 | Visitations-Abschied für Löbenicht-Königsberg | 1585 | 4, p. 144 | 1836 | Visitation | L | |
| 21 | Begräbnissordnung für Königsberg | 1585 | 4, p. 145 | 1837 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 22 | Abschied für Lyck | 1579 | 4, p. 147 | 1837 | Visitation | L | |
| 23 | Gottesdienstordnung für Marggrabowa | 1581 | 4, p. 149 | 1837 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 24 | Confirmation der Stadt Marienwerder | 1588 | 4, p. 150 | 1838 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 25 | Visitations-Abschied für Osterode | 1576 | 4, p. 151 | 1839 | Visitation | L | |
| 26 | Gottesdienstordnung für Sensburg | 1581 | 4, p. 151 | 1839 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 27 | Visitations-Abschied für Soldau | 1587 | 4, p. 152 | 1839 | Visitation | L | |
| 28 | Visitations-Abschied für Zinten | 1575 | 4, p. 153 | 1840 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.9.2 Royal Prussia: Danzig, Elbing, Thorn and their lands

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung für Danzig (Regest) | 1567 | 4, p. 168 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 29 | Armenordnung für Danzig | 1525 | 4, p. 175 | 1844 | Poor relief | L | |
| 30 | Armenordnung für Danzig | 1551 | 4, p. 176 | 1844 | Poor relief | L | |
| 31 | Kirchenordnung für Danzig | 1557 | 4, p. 181 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 32 | Köstenordnung für Danzig | 1564 | 4, p. 181 | 1844 | Marriage | L | |
| 33 | Gottesdienstordnung für die Marienkirche zu Danzig | 1567 | 4, p. 186 | 1844 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Entwurf einer Feiertagsordnung für Danzig um 1567 (33 Anm.) | 1567 | 4, p. 186 | 1844 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 34 | Kirchenordnung für Danzig | 1570 | 4, p. 188 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 35 | Chor-Ordnung für Danzig | 1572 | 4, p. 191 | 1844 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 36 | Rathsabschied für Danzig | 1573 | 4, p. 191 | 1844 | Visitation | L | |
| 37 | Begräbnissordnung für Danzig | 1578 | 4, p. 191 | 1844 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 38 | Decret des Senats von Danzig | 1586 | 4, p. 191 | 1844 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Köstenordnung für Danzig (39 u. 40) | 1590 | 4, p. 192 | 1844 | Marriage | L | |
| | Köstenordnung für Danzig (39 u. 40) | 1595 | 4, p. 192 | 1844 | Marriage | L | |
| 41 | Kirchenordnung für Danzig | 1612 | 4, p. 197 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 42 | Kirchenordnung für den Stüblauschen Werder | 1582 | 4, p. 218 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 43 | Kirchenordnung für Hela | 1583 | 4, p. 220 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 44 | Kirchenordnung für das Land bei Danzig | 1591 | 4, p. 221 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 45 | Bedenken für Elbing | 1570 | 4, p. 223 | 1844 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 46 | (Nach 1560) Kirchenordnung für Thorn | 1560 | 4, p. 228 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| | Ende des 16. Jahrhunderts. Gebet für den (polnischen) Landesherrn in Thorn (Regest) | 1599 | 4, p. 228 | 1844 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 47 | Kirchenordnung für Thorn | 1575 | 4, p. 233 | 1844 | Church order | L | |
| 48 | Kirchenordnung für Thorn | 1599 | 4, p. 244 | 1844 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.9.3 Greater Poland (Posen): synods, the Bohemian Brethren and the towns

- **Tradition**: Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed, Brethren).
- **Note**: Lutherans, Reformed and Bohemian Brethren lived side by side; the three joined in the Consensus of Sandomierz (1570), renewed by later general synods.
- **Texts by tradition**: Sandomierz consensus (Lutheran, Reformed, Brethren) 6, Lutheran 6, Reformed 3, Hussite (Bohemian Brethren) 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 49 | Synode von Sendomir | 1570 | 4, p. 257 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 50 | Synode von Posen | 1570 | 4, p. 258 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 51 | Synode von Krakau | 1573 | 4, p. 260 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 52 | Synode von Petrikau | 1578 | 4, p. 262 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 53 | Synode von Wladislaw | 1583 | 4, p. 263 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 54 | Synode von Thorn | 1595 | 4, p. 265 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | C | |
| 55 | Synode von Gostyn | 1565 | 4, p. 268 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Lutheran synod of Greater Poland |
| 56 | Synode von Xions (A. Protokoll-Auszug) | 1560 | 4, p. 270 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren |
| 57 | Synode von Xions (B. Conclusiones | 1560 | 4, p. 271 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren |
| 58 | Synode von Pinczow | 1561 | 4, p. 272 | 1846 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Little Polish Reformed, united with the Brethren |
| 59 | Kirchenordnung der Böhmischen Brüder | 1616 | 4, p. 273 | 1846 | Church order | H | Order of the Unity of the Brethren (synod of Zerawitz) |
| 60 | / Gottesdienstordnung für Fraustadt | 1564 | 4, p. 293 | 1848 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 61 | Kirchenordnung für Fraustadt | 1576 | 4, p. 294 | 1848 | Church order | L | |
| 62 | Willkür für Fraustadt | 1576 | 4, p. 296 | 1849 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 63 | Privileg für Lasswitz | 1575 | 4, p. 297 | 1850 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 62b | Rathsbeschluss für Fraustadt | 1591 | 4, p. 297 | 1850 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 64 | Privileg für Lissa | 1580 | 4, p. 298 | 1850 | Treaty / agreement | H | Lissa, a centre of the Brethren |
| 65 | Privileg für Ostrorog | 1569 | 4, p. 299 | 1851 | Treaty / agreement | H | Ostroróg, chief congregation of the Unity |

#### 1.9.4 Duchy of Pomerania

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Visitationsordnung für Rehfeld (Regest) | 1590 | 4, p. 315 | 1853 | Visitation | L | |
| 66 | Kirchenordnung für Pommern | 1535 | 4, p. 328 | 1855 | Church order | L | |
| 67 | Pia ordinatio für Pommern | 1535 | 4, p. 344 | 1856 | Church order | L | |
| 68 | Barnim's IX. Mandat wider Veräusserung kirchlicher Güter | 1540 | 4, p. 353 | 1858 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 69 | Kirchenordnung für Pommern | 1542 | 4, p. 354 | 1858 | Church order | L | |
| 70 | Visitations-Ordnung für Pommern | 1547 | 4, p. 370 | 1859 | Visitation | L | |
| 71 | Visitations-Verordnung für Pommern | 1556 | 4, p. 371 | 1859 | Visitation | L | |
| 72 | Verordnung des Herzogs Barnim von Pommern | 1557 | 4, p. 374 | 1860 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 73 | Kirchenordnung von Pommern | 1563 | 4, p. 375 | 1861 | Church order | L | |
| 74 | Visitations-Ausschreiben für Pommern | 1568 | 4, p. 375 | 1861 | Visitation | L | |
| 75 | Kirchenordnung für Pommern | 1560 | 4, p. 376 | 1861 | Church order | L | |
| 76 | Agenda für Pommern | 1560 | 4, p. 419 | 1863 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 77 | Consistorial-Instruktion für Pommern | 1560 | 4, p. 480 | 1865 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 78 | Statuta synodica für Pommern | 1574 | 4, p. 484 | 1867 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 79 | Leges praepositis ecclesiarum praescriptae für Pommern | 1591 | 4, p. 492 | 1868 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 80 | Ohne Datum. *Forma der gemeinen Beicht in Pommern | 1616 | 4, p. 494 | 1870 | Other | L | |
| 81 | Visitations-Abschied für Anclam | 1535 | 4, p. 495 | 1871 | Visitation | L | |
| 82 | Abschied für Anclam | 1572 | 4, p. 497 | 1871 | Visitation | L | |
| 83 | Abschied für Barth | 1536 | 4, p. 498 | 1871 | Visitation | L | |
| 84 | Klosterordnung für Colberg | 1586 | 4, p. 500 | 1872 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 85 | Abschied für Gollnow | 1537 | 4, p. 507 | 1875 | Visitation | L | |
| 86 | Abschied für Gollnow | 1595 | 4, p. 509 | 1875 | Visitation | L | |
| 87 | Abschied für Greifswald | 1535 | 4, p. 511 | 1876 | Visitation | L | |
| 88 | Vertrag zwischen dem Herzog und der Stadt Greifswald wegen der Superintendenz | 1553 | 4, p. 513 | 1877 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 89 | Kirchspielordnung für Lassan | 1563 | 4, p. 515 | 1878 | Church order | L | |
| 90 | Matrikel von Lindow | 1571 | 4, p. 516 | 1878 | Property / endowment | L | |
| 91 | Abschied für Pasewalk | 1535 | 4, p. 517 | 1879 | Visitation | L | |
| 92 | Abschied für Pyritz | 1539 | 4, p. 519 | 1879 | Visitation | L | |
| 93 | Visitationsordnung für Pyritz | 1586 | 4, p. 519 | 1879 | Visitation | L | |
| 94 | Visitations-Abschied für Stargard | 1596 | 4, p. 520 | 1879 | Visitation | L | |
| 95 | Kirchenstuhlordnung für Stargard | 1596 | 4, p. 520 | 1879 | Property / endowment | L | |
| 96 | Abschied für Stettin | 1535 | 4, p. 523 | 1880 | Visitation | L | |
| 97 | Verhandlung des Herzogs Barnim mit dem Rathe von Stettin | 1539 | 4, p. 529 | 1882 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 98 | Auszug aus der Matrikel für Stettin | 1540 | 4, p. 529 | 1882 | Property / endowment | L | |
| 99 | Consistorial-Beschluss für Stettin | 1573 | 4, p. 530 | 1882 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 100 | Abschied für Stettin | 1573 | 4, p. 531 | 1883 | Visitation | L | |
| 101 | Abschied für Stolp | 1535 | 4, p. 535 | 1884 | Visitation | L | |
| 102 | Abschied für Stolp | 1571 | 4, p. 536 | 1884 | Visitation | L | |
| 103 | Abschied für Stolp | 1590 | 4, p. 537 | 1884 | Visitation | L | |
| 104 | Kirchen- und Schulordnung für Stralsund | 1525 | 4, p. 542 | 1884 | School / university | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 105 | Kirchen- und Schulordnung für Stralsund. Publikationsbefehl des Rathes | 1525 | 4, p. 545 | 1886 | School / university | L | |
| 106 | Anhang zur Stralsunder Kirchen- und Schulordnung | 1525 | 4, p. 547 | 1887 | School / university | L | |
| 107 | Visitationsrezess und Kirchenordnung für Stralsund | 1535 | 4, p. 548 | 1887 | Church order | L | |
| 108 | Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung für Stralsund | 1555 | 4, p. 550 | 1888 | Church order | L | |
| 109 | Stralsunder Kleider- und Hochzeitsordnung | 1570 | 4, p. 552 | 1889 | Marriage | L | |
| 111 | Abschied für Wollin | 1535 | 4, p. 553 | 1889 | Visitation | L | |
| 110 | Matrikel von Usedom | 1577 | 4, p. 553 | 1889 | Property / endowment | L | |

## 1.10 Volume 5: Livonia, Estonia, Courland, Mecklenburg, Lübeck, Lauenburg, Hamburg

86 texts.

### 1.10.1 Livonia

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Verhandlungen der livländischen Städte zu Wolmar, 31. Januar | 1533 | 5, p. 6 | 1897 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| | Gottesdienstordnung für Riga | 1530 | 5, p. 11 | 1897 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Ordnung für die St. Johannisgemeinde zu Dorpat | 1550 | 5, p. 27 | 1898 | Local order | L | |
| | Verordnung wegen des Beichtens zu Dorpat | 1553 | 5, p. 27 | 1898 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat | 1553 | 5, p. 27 | 1898 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat | 1554 | 5, p. 29 | 1898 | Local order | L | |
| | Armen-Ordnung zu Dorpat | 1554 | 5, p. 29 | 1898 | Poor relief | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Dorpat | 1554 | 5, p. 30 | 1899 | Local order | L | |

### 1.10.2 Estonia (Reval)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Entwurf der Prediger zu Reval | 1524 | 5, p. 39 | 1901 | Other | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Reval | 1524 | 5, p. 40 | 1901 | Local order | L | |
| | Vorschlag Langes zu Reval, betr. den Gottesdienst | 1525 | 5, p. 40 | 1901 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Reval | 1525 | 5, p. 41 | 1902 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Reval über die Einkünfte | 1525 | 5, p. 41 | 1902 | Local order | L | |

#### 1.10.3 Courland

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenreformation für Kurland | 1570 | 5, p. 49 | 1904 | Church order | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Kurland | 1570 | 5, p. 66 | 1906 | Church order | L | |
| | Instructio generalis für Kurland | 1570 | 5, p. 79 | 1907 | Other | L | |
| | Ausschreiben Herzog Gottfrieds für Kurland | 1580 | 5, p. 110 | 1907 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Ausschreiben Herzog Gottfrieds für Kurland | 1583 | 5, p. 112 | 1908 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Visitations-Rezess für Nerfft | 1584 | 5, p. 112 | 1908 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Rezess für Nerft | 1591 | 5, p. 114 | 1909 | Visitation | L | |
| | Abschied für Grobin | 1560 | 5, p. 115 | 1910 | Visitation | L | |
| | Erlass des Herzogs Albrecht in Preussen für Grobin | 1561 | 5, p. 117 | 1911 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Sackenhausensche Kirchenordnung | 1568 | 5, p. 120 | 1911 | Church order | L | |
| | Sackenhausensche Kirchenordnung | 1586 | 5, p. 129 | 1916 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.10.4 Mecklenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Mandat der Herzöge zu Mecklenburg | 1560 | 5, p. 137 | 1919 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Befehl an die Bauern zu Schwichtenberg und Sandhagen | 1570 | 5, p. 139 | 1919 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Eid der Kirchengeschworenen in Mecklenburg | 1570 | 5, p. 139 | 1919 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg | 1535 | 5, p. 147 | 1920 | Visitation | L | |
| | Verordnung der Visitatoren für Mecklenburg | 1542 | 5, p. 148 | 1921 | Visitation | L | |
| | Ordeninge der misse für Mecklenburg | 1545 | 5, p. 150 | 1922 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Mecklenburg | 1552 | 5, p. 161 | 1922 | Church order | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg | 1552 | 5, p. 219 | 1923 | Visitation | L | |
| | Processus visitationis für Mecklenburg | 1552 | 5, p. 221 | 1924 | Visitation | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Mecklenburg | 1557 | 5, p. 224 | 1925 | Church order | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg | 1557 | 5, p. 224 | 1925 | Visitation | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Mecklenburg | 1560 | 5, p. 227 | 1925 | Visitation | L | |
| | Artikel für Mecklenburg | 1567 | 5, p. 229 | 1926 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| | Kirchengerichts- oder Consistori-Ordnung zu Mecklenburg | 1570 | 5, p. 231 | 1926 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Superintendenten-Ordnung für Mecklenburg | 1571 | 5, p. 247 | 1926 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Jungfrauen-Klosterordnung für Mecklenburg | 1572 | 5, p. 250 | 1926 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| | Ordnung für Fürstenberg | 1578 | 5, p. 262 | 1927 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Malchin | 1534 | 5, p. 266 | 1928 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Neubrandenburg | 1557 | 5, p. 267 | 1929 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Neubrandenburg | 1560 | 5, p. 270 | 1930 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths für Rostock | 1530 | 5, p. 281 | 1931 | Local order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Ordnung für Rostock | 1541 | 5, p. 282 | 1931 | Local order | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Rostock | 1557 | 5, p. 283 | 1932 | Visitation | L | |
| | Erbvertrag für Rostock | 1573 | 5, p. 284 | 1933 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| | Statuta etc. für Rostock | 1573 | 5, p. 285 | 1934 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| | Articuli für das Ministerium zu Rostock | 1574 | 5, p. 286 | 1935 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| | Conformitas ceremoniarum für Rostock | 1560 | 5, p. 288 | 1936 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Artikel für Predigtamtskandidaten zu Rostock | 1570 | 5, p. 291 | 1937 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| | Visitations-Instruktion für Rostock | 1578 | 5, p. 291 | 1937 | Visitation | L | |
| | Eheordnung für Rostock | 1581 | 5, p. 293 | 1938 | Marriage | L | |
| | Erbvertrag mit Rostock | 1584 | 5, p. 295 | 1938 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| | Bericht des Superintendenten Pauli zu Rostock | 1585 | 5, p. 298 | 1938 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Ehemandat für Rostock | 1585 | 5, p. 299 | 1939 | Marriage | L | |
| | Ordnung für Schwerin | 1541 | 5, p. 300 | 1940 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Wesenberg | 1567 | 5, p. 301 | 1941 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Wismar | 1541 | 5, p. 308 | 1942 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung des Raths zu Wismar | 1543 | 5, p. 311 | 1943 | Local order | L | |
| | Pia conjunctio zu Wismar | 1562 | 5, p. 311 | 1943 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Begräbnissordnung für Wismar | 1563 | 5, p. 312 | 1944 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | Abschied für Wismar | 1572 | 5, p. 312 | 1944 | Visitation | L | |
| | Begräbnissordnung zu Wismar | 1575 | 5, p. 314 | 1945 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Visitations-Instruktion für das Stift Schwerin | 1557 | 5, p. 316 | 1946 | Visitation | L | |
| | Consistorialordnung des Stifts Schwerin | 1567 | 5, p. 319 | 1947 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.10.5 Lübeck with Bergedorf

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung für Lübeck | 1531 | 5, p. 334 | 1949 | Church order | L | |
| | Erklärung des Raths zu Lübeck | 1575 | 5, p. 368 | 1949 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Senatsbeschluss von Lübeck | 1579 | 5, p. 369 | 1949 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Senatsbeschluss von Lübeck | 1582 | 5, p. 370 | 1949 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Decretum senatus zu Lübeck | 1582 | 5, p. 372 | 1949 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Deklaration des Raths zu Lübeck | 1588 | 5, p. 374 | 1949 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Ordnung des St. Johannisklosters zu Lübeck | 1569 | 5, p. 375 | 1949 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| | Ordnung für das lübeckische Landgebiet | 1531 | 5, p. 379 | 1950 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung der Stadt Mölln | 1531 | 5, p. 381 | 1950 | Local order | L | |
| | Ordnung für Travemünde | 1531 | 5, p. 382 | 1950 | Local order | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Bergedorf | 1544 | 5, p. 386 | 1950 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.10.6 Lauenburg and the Land Hadeln

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung für Lauenburg | 1585 | 5, p. 397 | 1953 | Church order | L | |
| | Polizeiordnung für Hadeln | 1599 | 5, p. 464 | 1955 | Discipline / police | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Hadeln | 1542 | 5, p. 465 | 1955 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.10.7 Hamburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung für Hamburg | 1529 | 5, p. 488 | 1957 | Church order | L | |
| | Hamburger Artikel | 1535 | 5, p. 540 | 1960 | Other | L | |
| | Kirchenordnung für Hamburg | 1556 | 5, p. 543 | 1962 | Church order | L | |
| | Mandat des Raths zu Hamburg | 1556 | 5, p. 556 | 1963 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| | Ordnung für Ritzebüttel (nach 1570) | 1570 | 5, p. 556 | 1963 | Local order | L | |

## 1.11 Volume 6/1: Lower Saxony I/1: Wolfenbüttel, Braunschweig, Lüneburg

26 texts.

### 1.11.1 Principality of Wolfenbüttel

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Visitations-Instruktionen im Herzogtum Wolfenbüttel. 1542 | 1542 | 6/1, p. 12 | 1971 | Visitation | L | |
| 2 | Christlike kerken-ordeninge im lande Brunschwig, Wulffenbüttels deles. 1543 | 1543 | 6/1, p. 22 | 1972 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung unser, von Gottes genaden Julii, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Lüneburg etc. 1569 (Register S. 278) | 1569 | 6/1, p. 83 | 1974 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Christlicher und gründlicher bericht, welcher gestalt die herrn und jungfrauenklöster im herzogthumb Braunschweig, Wulffenbütlischen theils … | 1569 | 6/1, p. 281 | 1975 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

### 1.11.2 Town of Braunschweig

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Der erbarn stadt Brunswig christlike ordeninge . . . Dorch Joannem Bugenhagen Pomeren bescreven. 1528 | 1528 | 6/1, p. 348 | 1981 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Ordnunge, wie es hinfuro mit den nominationibus, vocationibus und annhemunge der herren predicanten in den kirchen zu Braunschweig gleichformig und … | 1571 | 6/1, p. 456 | 1984 | Local order | L | |
| 3 | Acta inter senatum et ministerium in dimissione D. Joach. Morlini (Bestallungsordnung für M. Chemnitz). 1567 | 1567 | 6/1, p. 459 | 1986 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis, qui administerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur. [1571] | 1571 | 6/1, p. 471 | 1987 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 5 | Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern der stadt Braunschweigk. o.J | n.d. | 6/1, p. 473 | 1988 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6 | Artikel, in der visitation den pfarhern uberantwort | n.d. | 6/1, p. 476 | 1989 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Artikel, de visitation beider gerichte Asseborch und Eike belangen. [1546] | 1546 | 6/1, p. 478 | 1991 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.11.3 Principality of Lüneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Artikel, darinne etlike mysbruke by den parren des förstendoms Lüneborg entdecket unde darjegen gude ordenynge angegeven werden . . . 1527 | 1527 | 6/1, p. 492 | 1995 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 2 | Wie und was wir, Ernst, von Gots gnaden herzog zu Braunswick und Leuneborg, unsers furstenthumbs pharhern und predigern zu predigen befholen. [1529] | 1529 | 6/1, p. 522 | 2001 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Herzog Ernstes ordnung belangende der pastorn inkomen und ehesachen. [1543] | 1543 | 6/1, p. 528 | 2002 | Marriage | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnung: Wie es mit christlicher lere, reichung der sacrament, ordination der diener des evangelii, ordentlichen ceremonien, visitation ... | 1564 | 6/1, p. 533 | 2003 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Instruktionen zu den Visitationen im Fürstentum Lüneburg 1565 u. 1568 | 1568 | 6/1, p. 576 | 2006 | Visitation | L | |
| 6 | Visitationsartikel für das Fürstentum Lüneburg. 1583 | 1583 | 6/1, p. 580 | 2007 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Radtslach to nodtroft der kloster des förstendoms Lüneborch, Gades wort unde ceremonien belangen. 1530 | 1530 | 6/1, p. 586 | 2008 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis. [1555] | 1555 | 6/1, p. 609 | 2009 | Church order | L | |
| 9 | Klosterordnung des Herzogs Wilhelm d. J. für das Fürstentum Lüneburg. 1574 | 1574 | 6/1, p. 619 | 2010 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 10 | Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti in ducatu Luneburgensi. [1555] | 1555 | 6/1, p. 624 | 2011 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.11.4 Town of Lüneburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Christlyke ordenynghe van der scholen und kercken sacken der stadt Luneborch. Dorch Urbanum Rhegium. [1531] | 1531 | 6/1, p. 633 | 2013 | School / university | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg. 1575 | 1575 | 6/1, p. 650 | 2016 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Leges ministrorum verbi Dei in ecclesia civitatis Lunaeburgensis [ca. 1570] | 1570 | 6/1, p. 691 | 2020 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 4 | Leges ad solum scribam ministrorum verbi pertinentes. [ca. 1570?] | 1570 | 6/1, p. 694 | 2021 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 5 | Ordnung des gotteshauses in dem Grall. Anno 1598 | 1598 | 6/1, p. 695 | 2022 | Local order | L | |

## 1.12 Volume 6/2: Lower Saxony I/2: Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen, Hoya-Diepholz

26 texts.

### 1.12.1 Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | [Kirchenordnung der Herzogin Elisabeth von 1542] Christliche, bestendige und in der schrift und heiligen veteren wol gegrünte verklerung und … | 1542 | 6/2, p. 708 | 2028 | Church order | L | |
| | Catechismus odder kinderlahr … [Teil II] | 1542 | 6/2, p. 786 | 2036 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| | Christliche kirchenordnung, ceremonien und gesenge … [Teil III] | 1542 | 6/2, p. 788 | 2036 | Church order | L | |
| | Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung … [Teil IV] | 1542 | 6/2, p. 838 | 2037 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Ordenungh vor die klosterleuth … [1542] | 1542 | 6/2, p. 844 | 2037 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 3 | Instructio, was die verordenten visitatores in der durchleuchtigen und hochgebornen furstinnen und frauen, frauen Elisabet, … herzogin zu Brunsweig … | 1542 | 6/2, p. 855 | 2037 | Visitation | L | |
| 4 | Artikel, den gemeinen kasten belangent [1542] | 1542 | 6/2, p. 861 | 2038 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 5 | Reformation, gesetz und statuten unser, von Gotts gnaden Elisabet, … herzogin zu Braunschweigk und Luneburgk etc., witwen, so wir zu nutz, gedeien … | 1542 | 6/2, p. 862 | 2038 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Constitutiones aliquot synodales, das ist, etliche satzunge, so in zweien geistlichen versamlungen, deren eine zu Pattensen im | 1544 | 6/2, p. 866 | 2038 | Articles / statutes | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Visitatio generalis ducatus Calenbergici anno 1588 | 1588 | 6/2, p. 878 | 2040 | Visitation | L | |
| 8 | Landtagsabschied, so zwischen dem hochwürdigen, durchleuchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Heinrichen Julio, ... herzogen zu Braunschweig ... | 1601 | 6/2, p. 890 | 2042 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 9 | Reformation und Ordnung des Stifts Wunstorf ... 1598 | 1598 | 6/2, p. 896 | 2042 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.12.2 Town of Göttingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Christlike ordeninge der stadt Gottingen ... 1531 | 1531 | 6/2, p. 906 | 2044 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Christliche und in Gottes wort, altem und neuem testament. gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen ... 1568 | 1568 | 6/2, p. 916 | 2044 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.12.3 Town of Northeim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung der löblichen stadt Northeim, . . . gestellet durch D. Anto. Corvinum [1539] | 1539 | 6/2, p. 922 | 2046 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.12.4 Town of Hannover

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung der statt Hannofer durch D. Urbanum Regium ... 1536 | 1536 | 6/2, p. 944 | 2049 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.12.5 Principality of Grubenhagen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung für das Fürstentum Grubenhagen aus dem Jahre 1538 | 1538 | 6/2, p. 1028 | 2055 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Reformatio, das ist fürstliche braunschweigische kirchenordenung des durchleuchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und hern, hern Philips, herzogen zu … | 1544 | 6/2, p. 1031 | 2056 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Visitatio de anno 1544 zu Einbeck, Gruben und im gericht Soltderhelden | 1544 | 6/2, p. 1040 | 2057 | Visitation | L | |
| 4 | Des durchlauchtigen, hochgebornen fürsten und herren, herrn Wolffgangen, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Lüneburgk etc. christliche ordnung und befehl … | 1581 | 6/2, p. 1041 | 2058 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Christlicher abscheid deß durchleuchtigen und hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Philipsen, herzogen zu Brunschweig, anno 1583 seinen predigern … | 1583 | 6/2, p. 1103 | 2058 | Other | L | |
| 6 | Instruktion zur Abhaltung von Synode und Kirchengericht, gegeben von Herzog Wolfgang, Herzog zu Braunschweig und Lüneburg, Grubenhagenschen Teils, am … | 1582 | 6/2, p. 1107 | 2058 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7 | Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici. [1600] | 1600 | 6/2, p. 1109 | 2058 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.12.6 Town of Einbeck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Ordnung des Herzogs Philipps I. für die Stifter St. Alexandri und B. M. V. in Einbeck. 1543 | 1543 | 6/2, p. 1114 | 2060 | Local order | L | |

#### 1.12.7 Counties of Hoya and Diepholz

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung, wie es in religionssachen mit der seligmachenden lehr des heiligen göttlichen worts, christlicher administration der hochwirdigen … | 1581 | 6/2, p. 1128 | 2064 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Instruction, was sich unsere, von Gotts gnaden Wilhelmen des jungern, herzogen zu Braunschweig und Luneburg, rethe, kanzler und lieben, getreuen … … | 1571 | 6/2, p. 1204 | 2065 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.13 Volume 7/1: Lower Saxony II/1: Bremen (archbishopric), Verden, Osnabrück, East Frisia

47 texts.

### 1.13.1 Archbishopric of Bremen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Agenda Wursatorum ecclesiastica offte handbook unde ordeninge der hilligen kerken im lande to Wursten ...1574 | 1574 | 7/1, p. 16 | 2072 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Reformation und ordnung, so wir, von Gottes gnaden Heinrich, postulirter erzbischoff zu Bremen, administrator der stifte Oßnabrugk und Paderborn ... ... | 1580 | 7/1, p. 18 | 2072 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | [Vörder] Kirchenordnung. [1582] | 1582 | 7/1, p. 25 | 2073 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Unsere, eines erwirdigen bremischen tumbcapittels, erneuerte ordenung, wie es im flecken Vorde hinfüro mit den hochzeiten, kindelbieren und ... | 1587 | 7/1, p. 28 | 2073 | Marriage | L | |
| 5 | Visitationsankündigung für das Land Kehdingen und für Osten 1588 | 1588 | 7/1, p. 30 | 2074 | Visitation | L | |
| 6 | Visitationsanordnung für die Dompropstei 1593 | 1593 | 7/1, p. 32 | 2075 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Ordnung eins consistorii. [um 1616] | 1616 | 7/1, p. 33 | 2076 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Von Gottes gnaden unser, Johan Friedrichs, erwelten und postulierten zue erz- und bischoffen dero stifter Bremen und Lübeck ... verordnung, wie es ... | 1614 | 7/1, p. 39 | 2076 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

### 1.13.2 Town of Stade

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung in der stadt Stade. [ca. 1620/22] | 1620 | 7/1, p. 50 | 2078 | Church order | L | |

### 1.13.3 Town of Buxtehude

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Angenamen kerkenordeninge eynes erbarn rades der statt Buxtehude, gestellet dorch den erwerdigen, hochgelarten Doctorem Johannem Epinum … | 1552 | 7/1, p. 68 | 2081 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Buxtehuder Agende 1565 | 1565 | 7/1, p. 92 | 2082 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.13.4 Bishopric of Verden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit christlicher lehr und ceremonien, verreichung der h[eiligen], hoch[wirdigen] sacramenten und andern kirchensachen im stift … | 1606 | 7/1, p. 145 | 2086 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.13.5 Bishopric of Osnabrück

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kerckenordnunge vor de landkercken des stifts Osenbrugge, uffgerichtet und verordnet a r[everendissi]mo et ill[ustrissi]mo d[omino], d[omino] … | 1543 | 7/1, p. 222 | 2095 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Verordnung von Burgmännern und Rat zu Quakenbrück zur Einführung der Kirchenordnung des Bonnus 1543 | 1543 | 7/1, p. 227 | 2097 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni. Exercitium quotidianum in sacris scripturis et psalmis cantandis pro ecclesiis collegiatis... Anno 1543 | 1543 | 7/1, p. 229 | 2097 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.13.6 Town of Osnabrück

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Christliche kerkenordenunge der stadt Oßenbrugk. Anno Domini 1543 | 1543 | 7/1, p. 247 | 2099 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Agenda, das ist: Kirchenordnung, wie es in den evangelischen kirchen der statt Oßnabrück... sol gehalten werden. ..1618 | 1618 | 7/1, p. 265 | 2099 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Superattendentenordnung eins erbarn rats der statt Oßnabrügk. [1596] | 1596 | 7/1, p. 290 | 2101 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung 1610 | 1610 | 7/1, p. 296 | 2102 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Armenordnung der Stadt Osnabrück 1573(?)/1587 | 1587 | 7/1, p. 301 | 2102 | Poor relief | L | |

### 1.13.7 East Frisia: comital orders

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The counts' orders of 1529 and 1535 are Lutheran; under Countess Anna (1540-1561) and John a Lasco East Frisia was mixed, with Emden Reformed and much of the country Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 5, Moderate Reformed 1.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Ostfriesische Interimsordnung, 16. Juli 1549 (printed in the editor's introduction, n. 51) | 1549 | 7/1, p. 328 | 2105 | Church order | L | **Interim order** |
| 1 | Ordenunge und articule, so wy, Enno, grave und herr to Oestfreeslandt etc.,in unsen landen allen predicanten und underdanen gebaden hebben, ernstlick … | 1529 | 7/1, p. 360 | 2106 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Karckenordenynge vor dem pastoren unde kerckendenern … [1535] | 1535 | 7/1, p. 373 | 2107 | Church order | L | |
| | Volget, wes de Luinenborger predicanten, belangende des superattendenten und der predicanten, wo de schoelen geschickt und wat eer ampt sy | n.d. | 7/1, p. 383 | 2107 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Wo de beiden graven to Oestfreeslandt umtrent 20 articulen up de ordinantie … hebben in allen karcken der gravesscup Oestfreeslandt publiceren … | 1535 | 7/1, p. 393 | 2107 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Polizeiordnung der Gräfin Anna 1545 | 1545 | 7/1, p. 398 | 2108 | Discipline / police | MR | Countess Anna; John a Lasco superintendent 1543-1549 |

### 1.13.8 East Frisia: treaties

- **Tradition**: Reformed and Lutheran (treaty).
- **Note**: Settlements between the Lutheran count and Reformed Emden.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Delfzijlischer Vergleich 1595 | 1595 | 7/1, p. 414 | 2109 | Treaty / agreement | R/L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Die Konkordaten 1599 | 1599 | 7/1, p. 419 | 2110 | Treaty / agreement | R/L | |

### 1.13.9 East Frisia: Reformed orders of limited range (Norden, Emden, Leer, Lütetsburg; London)

- **Tradition**: Reformed.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | Dese nabeschrevene manier wert geholden to Norden alle Sondaechs na dat sermoen. [ca. 1528] | 1528 | 7/1, p. 431 | 2111 | Other | R | |
| 7 | Acta coetus pastorum ecclesiarum Frisiae Orientalis Embdae convenientium anno 76,13. die mensis Iunii | n.d. | 7/1, p. 434 | 2111 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 8 | Ordinatio coetus Leerani... [1583] | 1583 | 7/1, p. 440 | 2112 | Church order | R | |
| 9 | Ordnunge der vorsamlinge der predicanten und olderlingen... [vermutlich 1564/73] | 1564 | 7/1, p. 452 | 2113 | Local order | R | |
| 10 | Eine ordeninge der bedeleren, van den dieneren der gemeinte unde den vorstenderen, oldesten und dyaken binnen Embden utgebrocht... 1576 | 1576 | 7/1, p. 455 | 2113 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| | Ausführungsbestimmungen 1577-1579 | 1579 | 7/1, p. 460 | 2113 | Other | R | |
| 11 | Articulen der ordninge, darna man sich in die bieenkompsten der hueßitten diaconen richten sall etc. [ca. 1577/78] | 1577 | 7/1, p. 464 | 2113 | Articles / statutes | R | |
| 12 | Vormaninge vör und na der bedeninge des nachtmals in der kercken edder gemeine Christi in Embden. [1576] | 1576 | 7/1, p. 466 | 2113 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 13 | Articulen, darup Pauwel Hanssen tom organisten ein jair lank angenomen. Ao. 77 am 2. Octob | n.d. | 7/1, p. 475 | 2113 | Articles / statutes | R | |
| 14 | Summarische beschryvinge der ordnung in der christlicken kercken to Embden... [1594] | 1594 | 7/1, p. 480 | 2113 | Church order | R | |
| 15 | Ordnüng der dueitschen schoelen und der franzosischer schoelen. [1582] | 1582 | 7/1, p. 514 | 2113 | School / university | R | |
| 16 | Schulordnung der stadt Embden... 1596 | 1596 | 7/1, p. 517 | 2113 | School / university | R | |
| 17 | Eheordnung, wo idt mit dem hilligen ehestand und allem, wat dem angehorich... in der stadt Embden soll geholden werden... 1596 | 1596 | 7/1, p. 527 | 2114 | Marriage | R | |
| 18 | Kerckenordnüng in der gemene up dem huse Lutzborch. [1606] | 1606 | 7/1, p. 537 | 2115 | Church order | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | Kirchenordnung, wie die unter dem christlichen könig auß Engelland Edward dem VI. in der statt Londen in der niderlendischen gemeine Christi ... ... | 1565 | 7/1, p. 579 | 2116 | Church order | R | London Dutch stranger church (a Lasco, Micron) |

#### 1.13.10 East Frisia and Harlingerland: Lutheran orders of limited range

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | Armenordnung für Stadt und Kirchspiel Aurich 1578 | 1578 | 7/1, p. 668 | 2117 | Poor relief | L | |
| 21 | Liturgia Engerhovana ... Formulae baptizandi et administrandi s. coenam pro ecclesia Engerhovensi anno 1583 adornatae per Johannem Ligarium | 1583 | 7/1, p. 671 | 2118 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 22 | Marienhafer Kirchenordnung 1593 | 1593 | 7/1, p. 683 | 2119 | Church order | L | |
| 23 | Kirchenordnung der graff- und herrschaften Hoya, Rittpergh, Bruchausen, Esenß, Stedeßdorff und Wittmundt, 1574 | 1574 | 7/1, p. 725 | 2122 | Church order | L | |

### 1.14 Volume 7/2.1: Lower Saxony II/2.1: Hildesheim, Oldenburg, Jever

37 texts.

#### 1.14.1 Bishopric of Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Artickel den pfarherrn an beiden gerichten Stürwald und Pein ... vorzuhalten [1560] | 1560 | 7/2.1, p. 767 | 2128 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnunge in baiden gerichten, Steurwoldt unde Peine [1561] | 1561 | 7/2.1, p. 769 | 2129 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina [1574/89] | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 787 | 2130 | Appointment / oath | L | |

#### 1.14.2 Town of Hildesheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Christlike kerckenordeninge der löffliken stadt Hildenssem. Mit einer vörrede Antonii Coruini [1544] | 1544 | 7/2.1, p. 829 | 2136 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Up dem ebrock und ander horerye umegelesen (1543) | 1543 | 7/2.1, p. 885 | 2138 | Marriage | L | |
| 3 | Artikel, von den Angehörigen der Stifter und Klöster zu beschwören [1546] | 1546 | 7/2.1, p. 887 | 2138 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 4 | Ordnunge, wie es mit den frauwenstulen in der kirchen Sanct Pauli hinforder sol gehalten werden, 1551 | 1551 | 7/2.1, p. 893 | 2138 | Local order | L | |
| 5 | Geholdener radtschlag uff die heimliche ehevorleubnuß, unzugt und wuecher [1562] | 1562 | 7/2.1, p. 895 | 2138 | Marriage | L | |
| 6 | Bestallung des organisten Seuerini Krossenn auf 10 jaren (1571) | 1571 | 7/2.1, p. 899 | 2138 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7 | Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen, 1581 | 1581 | 7/2.1, p. 901 | 2138 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Eines erbaren rats der stad Hildeßheimb revidirte und verbesserte schuelordnung, 1574 | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 903 | 2138 | School / university | L | |
| 9 | Ratschlag uber alle kastenhern [1583] | 1583 | 7/2.1, p. 925 | 2138 | Poor relief | L | |
| 10 | Erziehung der jugend anordnung [1584] | 1584 | 7/2.1, p. 927 | 2138 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Einhelliger radtslag auf das ministerium und vormeretes consistorium in matrimonialsachen [1589] | 1589 | 7/2.1, p. 929 | 2138 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 12 | Eheordnung 1592 | 1592 | 7/2.1, p. 936 | 2138 | Marriage | L | |
| 13 | Bestallung M. Henrici Heshusii (1593) | 1593 | 7/2.1, p. 937 | 2138 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 14 | Ordnünge dero stadt Hildesheimb mit dem brantwein auf die Sontage wie auch mit dem schießen und wegen der hochzeit, 1597 | 1597 | 7/2.1, p. 941 | 2138 | Marriage | L | |

### 1.14.3 County of Oldenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der reinen lere göttliches worts ... in der löblichen graffschaft | 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 986 | 2146 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Oldenburg ... gehalten werden (Jena 1573) | | | | | | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung und wie sich die gemeine unter der predig und sonsten verhalten soll, 1574 | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 1163 | 2151 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Bestallunge deß superintendenten, 1574 | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 1164 | 2151 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 4 | Fundatio des armenhauses bey S. Gertruden ... vor Olldenburg, 1581 | 1581 | 7/2.1, p. 1165 | 2151 | Poor relief | L | |
| 5 | Vorrede zum Oldenburger Katechismus 1599 | 1599 | 7/2.1, p. 1168 | 2151 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 6 | Policeyordnung wegen der hochzeiten, kindtaufen, begrabnissen, kirchgäng und kirchmessen, 1606 | 1606 | 7/2.1, p. 1172 | 2151 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Articuli der oldenburgischen kirchenvisitation, 1609 | 1609 | 7/2.1, p. 1175 | 2151 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 8 | Visitationsabschiede 1609-1611 | 1609 | 7/2.1, p. 1196 | 2151 | Visitation | L | |
| 9 | Mandata, belangent die hochzeiten, kindtauften und kirchgenge alhier zue Delmenhorst [1601] | 1601 | 7/2.1, p. 1213 | 2152 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.14.4 Lordship of Jever

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Kirchenordnung des Fräulein Maria von Jever. Fragment, undated | n.d. | 7/2.1, p. 1215 | 2152 | Church order | L | |
| 11 | Kirchenzucht- und Polizeiordnung des Fräulein Maria von Jever, undated | n.d. | 7/2.1, p. 1220 | 2152 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Von heimlichen vorlöbniße und von wundarzten des ersten vorbands [1558] | 1558 | 7/2.1, p. 1223 | 2152 | Other | L | |
| 13 | Kerckenordeninge ... van der eddelen unde wolgebarn Maria ... to Jheuer ... corrigert dorch M. Petrum Rodtbart (1562) | 1562 | 7/2.1, p. 1225 | 2152 | Church order | L | |
| 14 | Leges generales novae scholae leverensis (Wittenberg 1573) | 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1246 | 2152 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 15 | Mandatum von überflüßigen süfen in kirchgangen, haußberungen, stoel-, kinder- und trostelbiere [1574] | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 1251 | 2152 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 16 | Mandatum wegen guter kirchendisciplin, so die predigern vermöge der kirchenordnung vor die zuhörern ... halten [1574] | 1574 | 7/2.1, p. 1254 | 2152 | Church order | L | |
| 17 | Wegen der hochzeit, kindelbiern, kirchgängen, kirchmeßen, gesellschaften und beysammendenkunften [1582] | 1582 | 7/2.1, p. 1256 | 2152 | Marriage | L | |
| 18 | Mandatum wegen ehebrecherey, hurerey, unzucht und heimlichen verlöbnißen [1585] | 1585 | 7/2.1, p. 1260 | 2152 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 19 | Von den armen und bettlern [1596] | 1596 | 7/2.1, p. 1263 | 2152 | Poor relief | L | |
| 20 | Currendeordnung de dato 23ten Augusti 1596 | 1596 | 7/2.1, p. 1265 | 2152 | Other | L | |

## 1.15 Volume 7/2.2: Lower Saxony II/2.2: Schaumburg, Goslar, Bremen (city)

98 texts.

### 1.15.1 County of Schaumburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Übergabe der Mecklenburgischen Kirchenordnung an die Pfarrer 5. Mai 1559 | 1559 | 7/2.2, p. 53 | 2159 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Einschärfung der Kirchenordnung 10. Mai 1560 | 1560 | 7/2.2, p. 55 | 2160 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Befehl zur Inventarisierung der Pfarreien und ihrer Kirchengüter 9. Juni 1562 | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 57 | 2161 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Weisung an die Konvente in Fischbeck und Obernkirchen zur Beachtung der Kirchenordnung und zur Abstellung der Messe und anderer Zeremonien 22. ... | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 59 | 2162 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Einführung einer Betmesse am Freitag 20. Februar 1563 | 1563 | 7/2.2, p. 61 | 2163 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6a | Berufung und Instruktion der Visitatoren 21. April 1564 | 1564 | 7/2.2, p. 62 | 2163 | Visitation | L | |
| 6b | Anweisungen für die Durchführung der Visitation 21. April 1564 | 1564 | 7/2.2, p. 63 | 2163 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Instruktion für die Visitatoren des Stifts Obernkirchen 8. Dezember 1564 | 1564 | 7/2.2, p. 64 | 2164 | Visitation | L | |
| 8 | Fragen bei der Visitation des Stifts Obernkirchen [um den 8. Dezember 1564] | 1564 | 7/2.2, p. 67 | 2165 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Zuchtmandat 24. Februar 1570 | 1570 | 7/2.2, p. 70 | 2166 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Garantie des Fortbestands des Stifts Möllenbeck [6. Mai 1570] | 1570 | 7/2.2, p. 72 | 2167 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 11 | Zuchtmandat 28. April 1576 | 1576 | 7/2.2, p. 76 | 2168 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Mandat zur Erhaltung der Kirchengüter und zur jährlichen Rechnungslegung 6. Juli 1577 | 1577 | 7/2.2, p. 77 | 2169 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 13 | Mandat zur Feier des Tages der Conversio Pauli 19. Januar 1587 | 1587 | 7/2.2, p. 78 | 2170 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14 | Verordnung zu den Eheverlöbnissen [1594] | 1594 | 7/2.2, p. 79 | 2171 | Marriage | L | |
| 15 | Vereinbarung für das Stift Fischbeck 27. Oktober 1602 | 1602 | 7/2.2, p. 81 | 2172 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 16 | Anweisungen für die Visitation des Stifts Obernkirchen 28. Januar 1603 | 1603 | 7/2.2, p. 84 | 2173 | Visitation | L | |
| 17 | Ordnung für das Stift Obernkirchen 6. August 1603 | 1603 | 7/2.2, p. 87 | 2174 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 18 | Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen 1603 | 1603 | 7/2.2, p. 91 | 2175 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 19 | Anweisung an die beiden Superintendenten zu verschiedenen Gegenständen 4. März 1609 | 1609 | 7/2.2, p. 93 | 2176 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 20 | Hausordnung für das Stift Möllenbeck 5. August 1612 | 1612 | 7/2.2, p. 95 | 2177 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 21 | Kirchenordnung 1614 | 1614 | 7/2.2, p. 99 | 2178 | Church order | L | |
| 22 | Von der Taufe unehelicher Kinder [vor 29. Juli] 1615 | 1615 | 7/2.2, p. 168 | 2179 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 23 | Anweisung an den Superintendenten zur neuen Kirchenordnung und zu den Kirchenrechnungen [nach 29. Juli 1615] | 1615 | 7/2.2, p. 169 | 2180 | Church order | L | |
| 24 | Weisungen zum Besuch der Gottesdienste und zur Heiligung Gottes 1615 | 1615 | 7/2.2, p. 171 | 2181 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.15.2 Imperial city of Goslar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Die „Articuli Jacobitarum“ 18. März 1528 | 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 223 | 2185 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 2 | Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat über die reformatorischen Änderungen in Nürnberg [30. März 1528] | 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 227 | 2186 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Gottesdienstordnung: Vom teglichen gots dinst [nach 8. März 1528] | 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 236 | 2187 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Ordnung der Gottesdienstzeiten für die Goslarer Pfarreien 24. April 1528 | 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 239 | 2188 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Gottesdienstordnung: Kyrchenordenung der stadt Goslar [1528/29] | 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 241 | 2189 | Other | L | |
| 6 | Beschluß des Rates, der Gilden und Meinheit, den Gottesdienst in den Stifts- und Klosterkirchen zu meiden 28. August 1529 | 1529 | 7/2.2, p. 243 | 2190 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Kirchenordnung [nach 24. Februar] 1531 | 1531 | 7/2.2, p. 244 | 2191 | Church order | L | |
| 8 | Beschluß zum Festhalten an der Reformation [13. März 1531] | 1531 | 7/2.2, p. 253 | 2192 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Verpflichtungserklärung eines nach Wittenberg entsandten Studenten 24. Juni 1533 | 1533 | 7/2.2, p. 257 | 2193 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 10a | Bestallungsurkunde für den Superintendenten Eberhard Widensee 8. September 1533 | 1533 | 7/2.2, p. 258 | 2193 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 10b | Revers des Superintendenten 2. Februar 1534 | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 260 | 2193 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 10c | Neuer Revers des Superintendenten 3. Juni 1540 | 1540 | 7/2.2, p. 261 | 2193 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 11 | Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas [1534/35] | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 262 | 2194 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 12 | Unterhaltung der Prädikanten und Lehrer aus dem Gemeinen Kasten 1537 | 1537 | 7/2.2, p. 266 | 2195 | Poor relief | L | |
| 13 | Zuchtordnung 16. Dezember 1537 | 1537 | 7/2.2, p. 269 | 2196 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 14 | Versorgungszusage für verarmte Söhne und Töchter früherer Stifter 3. November 1539 | 1539 | 7/2.2, p. 273 | 2197 | Other | L | |
| 15 | Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg 1542 | 1542 | 7/2.2, p. 275 | 2198 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 16a | Eingabe der Prädikanten zu den Klöstern und Stiften 18. Juli 1544 | 1544 | 7/2.2, p. 279 | 2198 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 16b | Stellungnahme des Rates zur Eingabe der Prädikanten 30. März 1545 | 1545 | 7/2.2, p. 287 | 2198 | Other | L | |
| 17 | Im Auftrag des Rates verfaßte Stellungnahme der Prädikanten zum Interim [14. Juli 1548] | 1548 | 7/2.2, p. 290 | 2199 | Other | L | **On the Interim** |
| 18 | Die „Neue Ordnung“ 25. September 1548 | 1548 | 7/2.2, p. 293 | 2200 | Other | L | **Interim year (civic order)** |
| 19 | Einigung zwischen dem Rat und den Prädikanten wegen der Versorgung der Witwen und Kinder 26. März 1550 | 1550 | 7/2.2, p. 301 | 2201 | Poor relief | L | |
| 20 | Berufung von Tilemann Heshusen zum Superintendenten 23. März 1553 | 1553 | 7/2.2, p. 302 | 2202 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 21 | Visitationsordnung 1. Juni 1554 | 1554 | 7/2.2, p. 304 | 2203 | Visitation | L | |
| 22 | Konsistorialordnung 1555/[nach 1561] | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 306 | 2204 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 23 | Bestätigung des Rates über die ihm von den Stiftsherren von St. Sixtus und Judas eingeräumte Verwendung von vier Präbenden 25. März 1555 | 1555 | 7/2.2, p. 317 | 2204 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 24a | Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes im Stift St. Simon und Judas 1560 | 1560 | 7/2.2, p. 319 | 2204 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 24b | Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes der Stifte St. Simon und Judas und St. Peter August 1566 | 1566 | 7/2.2, p. 322 | 2204 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 25 | Vergleich zur Versorgung der Witwen und Kinder der verstorbenen Geistlichen 7. August 1566 | 1566 | 7/2.2, p. 324 | 2205 | Poor relief | L | |
| 26 | Ordnung für das Spital St. Pankratius (Siechenhof) 24. Juni 1588 | 1588 | 7/2.2, p. 326 | 2206 | Poor relief | L | |
| 27 | Disziplinarmandat 22. Februar 1595 | 1595 | 7/2.2, p. 338 | 2207 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 28 | Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften 11. Mai 1595 | 1595 | 7/2.2, p. 339 | 2208 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 29 | Vertrag zwischen dem Rat der Stadt Goslar und dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Simon und Judas Mai 1605 | 1605 | 7/2.2, p. 341 | 2209 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 30 | Mandat zum pünktlichen Erscheinen beim Kirchgang der Brautleute 1612 | 1612 | 7/2.2, p. 343 | 2210 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 31 | Vertrag zwischen dem Rat der Stadt Goslar und dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Simon und | 1617 | 7/2.2, p. 344 | 2211 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Judas Januar 1617 | | | | | | |

### 1.15.3 City of Bremen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1562; Reformed from 1580.
- **Note**: Lutheran from 1525; the dispute over Albert Hardenberg, a pupil of Melanchthon (1556-1562), led to a Philippist church (1562-1579) and from 1580 to the 'Second Reformation'.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 16, Reformed 13, Philippist 9.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Evangelische Messe 1525 | 1525 | 7/2.2, p. 403 | 2216 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Einrichtung eines Armenkastens in der Liebfrauenkirche 16. April 1525 | 1525 | 7/2.2, p. 408 | 2217 | Poor relief | L | |
| 3a | Vereinbarung zwischen Erzbischof Christoph und der Stadt Bremen 23. September 1533 | 1533 | 7/2.2, p. 409 | 2217 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 3b | Vertrag zwischen Erzbischof Christoph und der Stadt Bremen 22. September 1534 | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 412 | 2217 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 4a | Ordnung der Gottesdienstzeiten für die Goslarer Pfarreien 24. April 1528: Kirchenordnung 1534 | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 416 | 2217 | Church order | L | |
| 4b | Annahme der Kirchenordnung durch den Rat der Stadt Bremen. Mandat gegen die Sakramentsschänder 1534 | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 484 | 2217 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Almosenordnung [nach 1534] | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 487 | 2218 | Poor relief | L | |
| 6 | Vergleich des Rates mit dem Kapitel des Stifts St. Wilhadi wegen der Verwendung der Präbenden 18. Mai 1545 | 1545 | 7/2.2, p. 490 | 2219 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 7 | Zuchtordnung 1546 | 1546 | 7/2.2, p. 493 | 2220 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 8 | Durchführung der Visitationen in den Landgemeinden 1551 | 1551 | 7/2.2, p. 497 | 2221 | Visitation | L | |
| 9a | Vom Rat geforderte Erklärung der Bremer Prediger zum Abendmahl 21. Oktober 1556 | 1556 | 7/2.2, p. 499 | 2221 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9b | Erklärung des Dompredigers Albert Hardenberg zum Abendmahl 9. November 1556 | 1556 | 7/2.2, p. 503 | 2221 | Agenda / liturgy | PH | Hardenberg |
| 10 | Mandat des Rates zum Verhalten der Bürger, nachdem der Streit zwischen Albert Hardenberg und den Bremer Predigern durch den Niedersächsischen Kreis … | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 505 | 2221 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11a | Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas [1534/35]: Kirchenordnung [nach 10. Oktober] 1561 | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 506 | 2221 | Church order | L | |
| 11b | Anfage der Wittheit an das Ministerium zu bestimmten Teilen der Kirchenordnung [November] 1561 | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 518 | 2221 | Church order | L | |
| 11c | Stellungnahme der Prediger zu den Anfragen der Wittheit [November oder Dezember] 1561 | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 520 | 2221 | Other | L | |
| 11d | Beschluß des Rates zu verschiedenen Artikeln der Kirchenordnung [Dezember 1561] | 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 530 | 2221 | Church order | L | |
| 11e | Entscheidung des Rates zum Artikel über die Binde- und Lösegewalt der Prediger in der Kirchenordnung [vor 3. Januar 1562] | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 533 | 2221 | Church order | PH | |
| 12 | Erlaß des Rates zu den Sakramentierern 3. Januar 1562 | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 537 | 2222 | Discipline / police | PH | |
| 13 | Mandat zur Enthaltung aller Streitigkeiten in Religionsangelegenheiten [Januar 1562] | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 539 | 2223 | Mandate / decree | PH | |
| 14 | Mandat zum Verbot des Scheltens auf der Kanzel und zur Predigt und Lehre gemäß der Heiligen Schrift und der Confessio Augustana [24. August 1562] | 1562 | 7/2.2, p. 540 | 2223 | Mandate / decree | PH | |
| 15 | Erklärung zum Festhalten an der Confessio Augustana, der Kirchenordnung von 1534, an Luthers Katechismus und dem Frankfurter Rezeß 25. Juli 1563 | 1563 | 7/2.2, p. 541 | 2224 | Confession / doctrine | PH | |
| 16 | Berufung von Markus Mening zum bremischen Superintendenten 7. September 1570 | 1570 | 7/2.2, p. 543 | 2225 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 17 | Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre 1572 | 1572 | 7/2.2, p. 546 | 2226 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 18 | Austrag des Konfliktes zwischen den Predigern und Jodokus Glaneus vor dem Rat 1. Januar 1575 | 1575 | 7/2.2, p. 564 | 2227 | Other | PH | |
| 19a | Bestallung des Predigers Joseph Naso 1582 | 1582 | 7/2.2, p. 566 | 2227 | Appointment / oath | R | |
| 19b | Bestallung des Predigers Johannes Varrelmann 1588 | 1588 | 7/2.2, p. 568 | 2227 | Appointment / oath | R | |
| 20 | Katechismus [1582/83] | 1582 | 7/2.2, p. 570 | 2228 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 21 | Leges conventuum ministerii 1585 | 1585 | 7/2.2, p. 579 | 2229 | Articles / statutes | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 22 | Ansetzung eines Kolloquiums für die Prediger des Landgebietes 16. September 1586 | 1586 | 7/2.2, p. 582 | 2230 | Other | R | |
| 23 | Hochzeitsordnungen [um 1588] | 1588 | 7/2.2, p. 583 | 2231 | Marriage | R | |
| 24 | Mandat gegen Hurerei, Ehebruch und Unzucht auf dem Land 20. Juni 1589 | 1589 | 7/2.2, p. 585 | 2232 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 25a | Beschwerdeschrift des geistlichen Ministeriums 20. Januar 1601 | 1601 | 7/2.2, p. 586 | 2232 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 25b | Stellungnahme des Rates zu den Gravamina des Ministeriums 24. März 1601 | 1601 | 7/2.2, p. 600 | 2232 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 26 | Einladung der Geistlichen des Landgebietes zu einem Kolloquium in Bremen 25. April 1601 | 1601 | 7/2.2, p. 608 | 2233 | Other | R | |
| 27 | Ordnung für die Feier der Hochzeiten und Kindertaufen 1606 | 1606 | 7/2.2, p. 609 | 2234 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 28 | Anlage eines Verzeichnisses der Kirchengüter, die zu den Pfarreien des Landgebietes gehören 1609 | 1609 | 7/2.2, p. 616 | 2235 | Property / endowment | R | |
| 29 | Mandat zu Trauungen, Bettagen und Friedhöfen 8. Dezember 1616 | 1616 | 7/2.2, p. 617 | 2236 | Mandate / decree | R | |

## 1.16 Volume 8: Hesse I

37 texts.

### 1.16.1 Landgraviate of Hesse under Philip (to 1567)

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Philip's church stood within the Wittenberg Concord but bore Bucer's stamp (Ziegenhain and Kassel, 1539), and the Kirchenordnung of 1566 belongs to the Strasbourg sphere; here counted as Moderate Reformed.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | a) Unser Landgrave Philipsen Reformation und ordenung von allerley gebrechlicheyt und unordenung 1526 | 1526 | 8, p. 37 | 2245 | Other | MR | |
| 1 | Reformatio Ecclesiarum Hassiae 1526 | 1526 | 8, p. 43 | 2247 | Church order | MR | |
| 2 | Stipendiatenordnung 1529 | 1529 | 8, p. 66 | 2250 | School / university | MR | |
| 3 | Wye sich die kastenmeinster halten sollen in irem ampt 1530 | 1530 | 8, p. 68 | 2251 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 4 | Ordenung, welcher massen hinfuro die pfarrer und ire helfer, diakon und alle kirchen diener | 1531 | 8, p. 71 | 2251 | Consistory / synod / | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | verordenet, gehanthabet, ... abgesatzt werden sall 1531 | | | | government | | |
| 5 | Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen in furstenthumb zu Hessen 1532 | 1532 | 8, p. 75 | 2252 | Church order | MR | |
| 6 | Ordtnung der Gottes- und Almosen-Casten 1533 | 1533 | 8, p. 80 | 2252 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 7 | Unser Philipsen von Gottes gnaden Lantgraven Zu Hessen ... Reformation und gemeine lands ordnung ... Auch ordenung und maß wie man mit den ... | 1537 | 8, p. 82 | 2252 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 8 | Ordenung wilcher masse hinfur die Visitatores, Pfarher, und yre helffer, Diacon und alle Kirchenndiener verordnet gehandthabt, und ... abgesatzt ... | 1537 | 8, p. 92 | 2252 | Visitation | MR | |
| 9 | Ordenung der Christlichen Kirchenn zucht, Für die Kirchen im Fürstenthumb Hessen 1539 | 1539 | 8, p. 101 | 2252 | Church order | MR | |
| 10 | Ordenung der Kirchenn übung, Für die Kirchen zu Cassel 1539 | 1539 | 8, p. 113 | 2253 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 10 | a) Der kurtze Catechismus... Für die Schüler und andere kinder zu Cassel 1539 | 1539 | 8, p. 131 | 2253 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 11 | Von Gots gnaden unser Philipsen Landgraven zu Hessen... Ordnung und bevelch, Wie es hinfürter mit den Stipendijs und Stipendiaten... gehalten werden ... | 1539 | 8, p. 143 | 2253 | School / university | MR | |
| 12 | Ordenung durch den durchleuchtigen, Hochgebornen Fürsten und herrn, herrn Philipsen, Landtgraven zu Hessen, ... Wie es mit den Stipendiaten... ... | 1542 | 8, p. 145 | 2254 | School / university | MR | |
| 13 | Ordenung von Gots gnaden, Unser Philipsen Landtgraven zu Hessen, ... Jn etlichen Notwendigen, zu erhaltung Christlicher Zucht .. .dienlichen Puncten ... | 1543 | 8, p. 148 | 2254 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 14 | Stipendiatenordnung 1546 | 1546 | 8, p. 155 | 2255 | School / university | MR | |
| 15 | Ordenung Christlicher Lehre und Zuchtt 1557 | 1557 | 8, p. 161 | 2256 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 16 | Ordenung Unser Philipsen von Gots gnaden Landtgraven zu Hessen ... Wie wir wöllen, Das es hinfürter in unserer Universitet zu Marpurg mit den ... | 1560 | 8, p. 166 | 2256 | School / university | MR | |
| 17 | Ordenung wie mans mit den pfar und castengüter allenthalben halten soll 1564 | 1564 | 8, p. 176 | 2257 | Local order | MR | |
| 18 | Kirchen Ordnung: Wie sich die Pfarherrn und Seelsorger in jrem beruff ... halten sollen 1566 | 1566 | 8, p. 178 | 2257 | Other | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | Fürstliche ordnunge von ... der kyrchenn dieners und Gotts kastenn. o.J | n.d. | 8, p. 338 | 2257 | Poor relief | MR | |

### 1.16.2 The Hessian landgraviates: joint synods and orders (1567-1582)

- **Tradition**: Philippist.
- **Note**: The joint synods held to the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* of 1560 and refused the Formula of Concord; the Agenda of 1574 keeps the Hessian order of 1566.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | Abschied der ersten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1568 | 1568 | 8, p. 347 | 2262 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 21 | Abschied der zweiten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1569 | 1569 | 8, p. 351 | 2263 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 22 | Abschied der dritten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1571 | 1571 | 8, p. 354 | 2263 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 23 | Abschied der vierten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1572 | 1572 | 8, p. 364 | 2263 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 24 | Abschied der fünften Generalsynode zu Marburg 1573 | 1573 | 8, p. 367 | 2263 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 25 | Abschied der sechsten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1574 | 1574 | 8, p. 371 | 2265 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 26 | Abschied der siebten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1575 | 1575 | 8, p. 373 | 2266 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 27 | Die achte Generalsynode zu Kassel 1576 | 1576 | 8, p. 377 | 2267 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 28 | Abschied des Konvents zu Treysa 1577 | 1577 | 8, p. 377 | 2267 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 29 | Abschied der neunten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1578 | 1578 | 8, p. 379 | 2268 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 30 | Abschied der zehnten Generalsynode zu Kassel 1579 | 1579 | 8, p. 383 | 2269 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 31 | Abschied der elften Generalsynode zu Marburg 1580 | 1580 | 8, p. 386 | 2270 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 32 | Abschied der zwölften Generalsynode zu Kassel 1581 | 1581 | 8, p. 389 | 2271 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 33 | Abschied der dreizehnten Generalsynode zu Marburg 1582 | 1582 | 8, p. 392 | 2272 | Consistory / synod / government | PH | |
| 34 | Ordnung und Reformation Unser von Gotts gnaden Wilhelms, Ludwigs, Philipsen und Georgens, Gebrüder Landtgraven zu Hessen 1572 | 1572 | 8, p. 394 | 2272 | Local order | PH | |
| 35 | Agenda Das ist: Kirchenordnung wie es im Fürstenthumb Hessen mit verkündigung Göttliches worts, reichung der heiligen Sacramenten und andern … | 1574 | 8, p. 408 | 2272 | Church order | PH | |

## 1.17 Volume 9: Hesse II: divided Hesse, Waldeck, Solms, Erbach, Frankfurt, Wetterau cities

101 texts.

### 1.17.1 Divided Hesse (1582-1618)

- **Tradition**: Philippist; Reformed in Hessen-Kassel from 1600; Lutheran in Hessen-Darmstadt.
- **Note**: Hessen-Marburg (to 1604) and Hessen-Darmstadt stayed Lutheran; Hessen-Kassel under Moritz turned Reformed (Katzenelnbogen 1600, 'Verbesserungspunkte' 1605).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 11, Philippist 5, Lutheran 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reversformular für die Theologen der Universität Marburg [1583] | 1583 | 9, p. 49 | 2287 | School / university | PH | |
| 2 | Artikel und Revers der Theologen an der Universität Marburg 1592 | 1592 | 9, p. 51 | 2287 | Articles / statutes | PH | |
| 3a | Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1597 | 1597 | 9, p. 53 | 2287 | Appointment / oath | PH | |
| 3b | Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1598 | 1598 | 9, p. 54 | 2287 | Appointment / oath | PH | |
| 4a | Konfessionswechsel in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1600: Visitationsbericht des Superintendenten Christian Zindel | 1600 | 9, p. 57 | 2287 | Visitation | R | |
| 4b | Konfessionswechsel in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen 1600: Resolution Landgraf Moritz' zum Visitationsbericht | 1600 | 9, p. 66 | 2287 | Visitation | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Mandat zur Einführung der Verbesserungspunkte 1605 | 1605 | 9, p. 69 | 2287 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 6 | Mandat für die Superintendenten zur Provinzialsynode 1607 | 1607 | 9, p. 71 | 2287 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 7a | Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Abschied | 1607 | 9, p. 73 | 2287 | Treaty / agreement | R | |
| 7b | Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Bekenntnis | 1607 | 9, p. 86 | 2287 | Confession / doctrine | R | |
| 7c | Die Kasseler Generalsynode 1607: Katechismus | 1607 | 9, p. 91 | 2287 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 8 | Konsistoriumsordnung 1610 | 1610 | 9, p. 99 | 2287 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 9 | Eheordnung 1608 | 1608 | 9, p. 122 | 2287 | Marriage | R | |
| 10 | Visitationsinstruktion für das Konsistorium [1610] | 1610 | 9, p. 133 | 2287 | Visitation | R | |
| 11 | Schulordnung 1618 | 1618 | 9, p. 136 | 2287 | School / university | R | |
| 12 | Polizeiordnung [1574] | 1574 | 9, p. 139 | 2287 | Discipline / police | PH | |
| 13 | Predigerwitwenmandat 1604 | 1604 | 9, p. 149 | 2287 | Poor relief | L | Hessen-Darmstadt |
| 14a | Regierungsordnung 1617: Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana | 1617 | 9, p. 150 | 2287 | Mandate / decree | L | Hessen-Darmstadt |
| 14b | Regierungsordnung 1617: Definitoriumsordnung zur Besetzung kirchlicher Stellen | 1617 | 9, p. 154 | 2287 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Hessen-Darmstadt |

#### 1.17.2 County of Waldeck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Landordnung 1525 | 1525 | 9, p. 177 | 2300 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung [1525] | 1525 | 9, p. 180 | 2300 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Reformationsmandat für die Johanniterkommende Niederwildungen 1527 | 1527 | 9, p. 184 | 2300 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen 1528 | 1528 | 9, p. 185 | 2300 | Consistory / synod / | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | government | | |
| 5 | Die Agende von Johann Hefentreger 1524-1539 5a/g. Glaubensbekenntnis und Bekenntnisordnung für die Stadt Waldeck 1529/1534 | 1534 | 9, p. 187 | 2300 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 5h | Die Agende von Johann Hefentreger 1524-1539 5a/g. Glaubensbekenntnis und Bekenntnisordnung für die Stadt Waldeck 1529/1534: Niederwildunger … | 1533 | 9, p. 191 | 2300 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 6 | Kastenordnung für Niederwildungen [1532] | 1532 | 9, p. 193 | 2300 | Poor relief | L | |
| 7 | Mandat zur Amts- und Lebensführung der Geistlichen 1539 | 1539 | 9, p. 199 | 2300 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Die „Wildunger Artikel“ der Superintendenten 1539 | 1539 | 9, p. 200 | 2300 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 9 | Synodalbestimmung 1541 | 1541 | 9, p. 202 | 2300 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 10a | Kastenordnung für die Stadt Rhoden: Kastenverwaltungsordnung 1542 | 1542 | 9, p. 203 | 2300 | Poor relief | L | |
| 10b | Kastenordnung für die Stadt Rhoden: Ausführungsbestimmungen zur Kastenverwaltungsordnung 1543 | 1543 | 9, p. 206 | 2300 | Poor relief | L | |
| 11 | Kastenordnung für Korbach 1543 | 1543 | 9, p. 208 | 2300 | Poor relief | L | |
| 12 | Predigerordnung für Korbach 1545 | 1545 | 9, p. 216 | 2300 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 13 | Reformationsordnung für das Kloster Flechtdorf 1543 | 1543 | 9, p. 220 | 2300 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 14a | Mandat gegen Trunksucht und Fastnachtsbräuche in Korbach 1547 | 1547 | 9, p. 222 | 2300 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14b | Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnungen: Mandat zum Gebet für Erhalt des evangelischen Glaubens 1553 | 1553 | 9, p. 223 | 2300 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14c | Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnungen: Kirchen- und Zuchtordnung 1555 | 1555 | 9, p. 225 | 2300 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 15 | Kirchenordnung 1556 | 1556 | 9, p. 229 | 2300 | Church order | L | |
| 16 | Mandat zur Einsetzung von Visitatoren 1558 | 1558 | 9, p. 296 | 2301 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | Mandat gegen Fastnachtsbräuche 1563 | 1563 | 9, p. 297 | 2301 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 18 | Visitationsmandat 1569 | 1569 | 9, p. 298 | 2301 | Visitation | L | |
| 19 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste 1583 | 1583 | 9, p. 299 | 2301 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 20 | Mandat zur Abschaffung von Taufexorzismus und Taufkleid 1584 | 1584 | 9, p. 300 | 2301 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 21 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Fastnachtsfeiern 1589/1590 | 1590 | 9, p. 301 | 2301 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 22 | Visitationsmandat 1589 | 1589 | 9, p. 303 | 2302 | Visitation | L | |
| 23 | Feiertagsordnung 1590 | 1590 | 9, p. 305 | 2303 | Discipline / police | L | |

### 1.17.3 County of Solms

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Solms-Braunfels (with the Hungen classis) turned Reformed from 1582; Solms-Laubach stayed Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 7, Lutheran 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1582 | 1582 | 9, p. 321 | 2311 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 2 | Strafordnung zur Kirchenzuchtordnung 1584 | 1584 | 9, p. 326 | 2311 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 3 | Artikel der Hungener Klasse zu den Klassikalkonventen 1583 | 1583 | 9, p. 329 | 2311 | Articles / statutes | R | |
| 4 | Auszug aus dem Abschied des Konsistorialkonvents 1588 | 1588 | 9, p. 332 | 2311 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 5 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1594 | 1594 | 9, p. 333 | 2311 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 6 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1599 | 1599 | 9, p. 339 | 2311 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 7 | Hochzeits- und Taufordnung für Solms-Hungen 1616 | 1616 | 9, p. 344 | 2311 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 8 | Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung für Münzenberg [1575-1580] | 1580 | 9, p. 346 | 2311 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 9 | Kirchenordnung für Solms-Laubach [1576-1580] | 1580 | 9, p. 355 | 2311 | Church order | L | |
| 10 | Kirchenzuchtordnung für Solms-Laubach 1603 | 1603 | 9, p. 398 | 2311 | Discipline / police | L | |

### 1.17.4 County of Erbach

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung von Michelstadt 1544 | 1544 | 9, p. 419 | 2316 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Erbacher Kirchenordnung 1560 | 1560 | 9, p. 421 | 2316 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Eheordnung 1572 | 1572 | 9, p. 450 | 2316 | Marriage | L | |
| 4 | Superintendentenrevers 1575 | 1575 | 9, p. 455 | 2316 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Instruktion in Kirchensachen 1577 | 1577 | 9, p. 457 | 2316 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 6 | Ordnung der Wiederverheiratung 1587 | 1587 | 9, p. 459 | 2316 | Local order | L | |

### 1.17.5 County of Stolberg-Königstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung für die Pfarrei Königstein 1540 | 1540 | 9, p. 467 | 2320 | Church order | L | |

### 1.17.6 Imperial city of Frankfurt

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1535.
- **Note**: Upper German in the early 1530s, then Lutheran (Wittenberg Concord 1536); the refugee churches are listed under their own confessions.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 19, Moderate Reformed 4, Reformed 2, Anglican 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Predigt- und Abendmahlsordnung 1530 | 1530 | 9, p. 495 | 2331 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 2a | Suspendierung der Messe 1533: Ratsbefehl | 1533 | 9, p. 501 | 2331 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 2b | Suspendierung der Messe 1533: Protestationsinstrument | 1533 | 9, p. 502 | 2331 | Other | MR | |
| 3 | Predigt- und Kirchenordnung [1533] | 1533 | 9, p. 505 | 2332 | Church order | MR | |
| 4a | Mandate gegen abweichende theologische Lehren: Täufermandat 1535 | 1535 | 9, p. 507 | 2332 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4b | Mandat gegen Prediger zwinglischer und calvinischer Lehren [1537] | 1537 | 9, p. 508 | 2332 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Resolution auf die Gravamina der Prediger 1542 | 1542 | 9, p. 509 | 2332 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 6 | Ordnung der Gottesdienstverteilung [1543] | 1543 | 9, p. 512 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7a | Übereinkunft der Prediger zu Taufe, Eheeinsegnung und Pfarrkonventen | 1543 | 9, p. 514 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7b | Agenden zu Taufe, Abendmahl und Krankenbesuch [1543]: Agende für Taufe und Krankenabendmahl | 1543 | 9, p. 516 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7c | Agenden zu Taufe, Abendmahl und Krankenbesuch [1543]: Abendmahlsagende | 1543 | 9, p. 520 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Gottesdienstordnung 1546 | 1546 | 9, p. 522 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9 | Verzeichnis der Fest- und Feiertage 1553 | 1553 | 9, p. 523 | 2332 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Agende 1553 | 1553 | 9, p. 524 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 11 | Organisation der Almosensammlung 1583 | 1583 | 9, p. 535 | 2332 | Poor relief | L | |
| 12a | Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente: Beschluss der Konventssitzung 1586 | 1586 | 9, p. 536 | 2332 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 12b | Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente: Konventsordnung 1618 | 1618 | 9, p. 537 | 2332 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 13 | Agende 1589 | 1589 | 9, p. 539 | 2332 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 14 | Liturgia sacra - Kirchenordnung der französisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1554 | 1554 | 9, p. 562 | 2332 | Church order | R | French Reformed congregation (Poullain) |
| 15 | Diakonieordnung der französisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1585 | 1585 | 9, p. 587 | 2332 | Consistory / synod / government | R | French Reformed congregation |
| 16 | Old discipline - New discipline/Ordnung der englisch-reformierten Gemeinde 1557 | 1557 | 9, p. 588 | 2332 | Other | A | English exile congregation (Marian exiles) |
| 17a | Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585: Stiftungsbrief - französisches Original | 1585 | 9, p. 601 | 2332 | Other | L | Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17b | Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585: Stiftungsbrief - deutsche Abschrift | 1585 | 9, p. 603 | 2332 | Other | L | Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession |
| 18a | Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - niederländisches Original | 1597 | 9, p. 605 | 2332 | Other | L | Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession |
| 18b | Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - französisches Original | 1597 | 9, p. 609 | 2332 | Other | L | Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession |
| 18c | Punkte und Artikel der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C. 1585/1597: Punkte und Artikel - deutsche Abschrift | 1597 | 9, p. 612 | 2332 | Other | L | Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession |

### 1.17.7 Imperial castle and city of Friedberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Wiedererrichtung des Friedberger Landkapitels als evangelische Institution 1565 | 1565 | 9, p. 627 | 2338 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Stadt-Friedberger Taufordnung [1619] | 1619 | 9, p. 631 | 2338 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Burg-Friedberger Trauformular [vor 1576] | 1576 | 9, p. 633 | 2338 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Burg-Friedberger Judentaufformular [um 1600] | 1600 | 9, p. 635 | 2338 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.17.8 Imperial city of Gelnhausen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Eheordnung 1566 | 1566 | 9, p. 645 | 2341 | Marriage | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung [1568] | 1568 | 9, p. 652 | 2341 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Stadt-, Polizei- und Kirchenzuchtordnung [1599] | 1599 | 9, p. 655 | 2341 | Discipline / police | L | |

### 1.17.9 Imperial city of Wetzlar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Reformed 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vergleich zwischen Stift und Stadt zur gemeinsamen Nutzung der Stiftskirche 1561 | 1561 | 9, p. 673 | 2346 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 2 | Verbot, geistliche Gerichte anzurufen 1571 | 1571 | 9, p. 676 | 2346 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Vertrag zur Pfarrer- und Schulmeisterbesoldung 1572 | 1572 | 9, p. 677 | 2346 | School / university | L | |
| 4 | Dekret zur Aufnahme der französisch-reformierten Flüchtlingsgemeinde 1586 | 1586 | 9, p. 678 | 2346 | Mandate / decree | R | for the French Reformed refugee congregation |
| 5 | Dekret für die französisch-reformirte Flüchtlingsgemeinde 1596 | 1596 | 9, p. 679 | 2347 | Mandate / decree | R | for the French Reformed refugee congregation |

## 1.18 Volume 10: Hesse III: Nassau, Hanau-Münzenberg, Ysenburg

99 texts.

### 1.18.1 Nassau-Dillenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Philippist from 1573; Reformed from 1578.
- **Note**: Lutheran under Wilhelm I and early Johann VI; from 1573 a 'Second Reformation', Reformed by 1578/1581.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 14, Reformed 14, Philippist 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung [um 1532] | 1532 | 10, p. 57 | 168 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung [1537] | 1537 | 10, p. 64 | 169 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung für Hadamar 1546 | 1546 | 10, p. 88 | 170 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Visitationsordnung 1550 | 1550 | 10, p. 90 | 171 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Synodalabschied 1552 | 1552 | 10, p. 93 | 172 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Visitationsordnung 1553 | 1553 | 10, p. 96 | 173 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Ehemandat 1561/1563 | 1563 | 10, p. 98 | 174 | Marriage | L | |
| 8 | Kirchgangsmandat 1563 | 1563 | 10, p. 100 | 175 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 9 | Kirchenzuchtmandat 1563 | 1563 | 10, p. 101 | 176 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Revers der Kirchendiener in Nassau-Diez [1564] | 1564 | 10, p. 103 | 177 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 11 | Kirchgangsmandat 1567 | 1567 | 10, p. 104 | 178 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12 | Anordnung einer Generalvisitation 1570 | 1570 | 10, p. 105 | 179 | Visitation | L | |
| 13 | Visitationsabschied und Kirchenordnung 1570 | 1570 | 10, p. 108 | 180 | Church order | L | |
| 14 | Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel 1570 | 1570 | 10, p. 130 | 181 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 15 | Agende [1575] | 1575 | 10, p. 146 | 182 | Agenda / liturgy | PH | |
| 16 | Reformationsmandat für Stadt und Amt Siegen 1581 | 1581 | 10, p. 158 | 183 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 17 | Kirchenordnung 1582 | 1582 | 10, p. 160 | 184 | Church order | R | |
| 18 | Ordnung für die Spezialkonsistorien [1582] | 1582 | 10, p. 165 | 185 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 19 | Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode 1582 | 1582 | 10, p. 167 | 186 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 20 | Zaubereimandat 1582 | 1582 | 10, p. 175 | 187 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 21 | Mandat gegen leichtfertige Tänze und andere Bräuche 1585 | 1585 | 10, p. 176 | 188 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 22 | Visitationspunkte für Nassau-Diez 1585 | 1585 | 10, p. 177 | 189 | Visitation | R | |
| 23 | Abschied der Herborner Generalsynode 1586 | 1586 | 10, p. 179 | 190 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 24 | Almosenordnung 1589 | 1589 | 10, p. 182 | 191 | Poor relief | R | |
| 25 | Verordnung in Kirchensachen 1597 | 1597 | 10, p. 190 | 192 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 26 | Bettagsmandat 1607 | 1607 | 10, p. 191 | 193 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 27 | Punkte für die Geistlichen im Amt Siegen 1611 | 1611 | 10, p. 194 | 194 | Other | R | |
| 28 | Visitationsabschied 1611 | 1611 | 10, p. 197 | 195 | Visitation | R | |
| 29 | Kirchgangsmandat 1618 | 1618 | 10, p. 202 | 196 | Discipline / police | R | |

#### 1.18.2 Nassau-Weilburg and Nassau-Saarbrücken

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 30 | Ordnung des Almosenkastens 1533/1554 | 1554 | 10, p. 204 | 197 | Poor relief | L | |
| 31 | Feiertags- und Kirchenordnung 1554 | 1554 | 10, p. 206 | 197 | Church order | L | |
| 32 | Kirchenordnung 1574/1576 | 1576 | 10, p. 208 | 197 | Church order | L | |
| 33 | Kirchenzuchtordnung für das Amt Wehen [nach 1602] | 1602 | 10, p. 320 | 198 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 34 | Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung 1609 | 1609 | 10, p. 324 | 198 | Church order | L | |
| 35 | Mandat zu Dispensen für Verwandtschaftsehen 1613 | 1613 | 10, p. 346 | 198 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 36 | Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung 1617 | 1617 | 10, p. 347 | 198 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.18.3 Nassau-Wiesbaden and Nassau-Idstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 37 | Extrakt des Eheedikts von 1582 | 1582 | 10, p. 358 | 200 | Marriage | L | |
| 38 | Ehemandat 1588 | 1588 | 10, p. 361 | 200 | Marriage | L | |
| 39 | Predigermandat 1589 | 1589 | 10, p. 364 | 200 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 40 | Extrakt des Ehebruchedikts 1590 | 1590 | 10, p. 368 | 200 | Marriage | L | |

#### 1.18.4 County of Hanau-Münzenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1595.
- **Note**: Lutheran until 1595, then Reformed (orders of 1609).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 24, Lutheran 5.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reformordnung für das Kloster Schlüchtern 1543 | 1543 | 10, p. 393 | 203 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 2a | Visitation 1577: Visitationsausschreiben | 1577 | 10, p. 396 | 203 | Visitation | L | |
| 2b | Kirchenordnung [1537]: Visitation 1577: Visitationsinstruktion | 1577 | 10, p. 398 | 203 | Visitation | L | |
| 3 | Eheordnung 1578 | 1578 | 10, p. 400 | 204 | Marriage | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenratsordnung [1580-1583] | 1583 | 10, p. 407 | 205 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim 1596 | 1596 | 10, p. 410 | 206 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 6a | Visitation 1597: Mandat zu Visitation und Sittenzucht | 1597 | 10, p. 411 | 206 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 6b | Visitationsordnung 1553: Visitation 1597: Visitationsinstruktion | 1597 | 10, p. 415 | 206 | Visitation | R | |
| 7 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1599/1602 | 1602 | 10, p. 416 | 207 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 8 | Kirchenzuchtordnung für die Stadt Hanau [nach 1599] | 1599 | 10, p. 425 | 208 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 9a | Visitation 1599/1600: Visitationsinstruktion [1599] | 1599 | 10, p. 427 | 208 | Visitation | R | |
| 9b | Visitation 1599/1600: Entwurf von Visitationsfragen 1599 | 1599 | 10, p. 432 | 208 | Visitation | R | |
| 9c | Visitation 1599/1600: Visitationsfragen [um 1600] | 1600 | 10, p. 436 | 208 | Visitation | R | |
| 10 | Ordnung der Landesverwaltung 1600 | 1600 | 10, p. 439 | 209 | Local order | R | |
| 11 | Almosenordnung [1600] | 1600 | 10, p. 443 | 210 | Poor relief | R | |
| 12a | Katechisation 1609: Auslegung der 23 Fragstücke zum Heidelberger Katechismus | 1609 | 10, p. 458 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12b | Katechisation 1609: Anordnung der Katechisation in Stadt und Amt Windecken | 1609 | 10, p. 468 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12c | Katechisation 1609: Vortrag zur Katechisation in der Stadt Windecken | 1609 | 10, p. 475 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12d | Katechisation 1609: Mandat zur Katechisation in der Stadt Windecken | 1609 | 10, p. 477 | 211 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 12e | Katechisation 1609: Anordnung der Katechisation in Hanau | 1609 | 10, p. 480 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12f | Katechisation 1609: Ordnung der Katechisation | 1609 | 10, p. 486 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12g | Katechisation 1609: Instruktion zur Katechisationsordnung | 1609 | 10, p. 494 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12h | Katechisation 1609: Instruktion zur Katechisation | 1609 | 10, p. 496 | 211 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 12i | Katechisation 1609: Konfirmationsordnung | 1609 | 10, p. 498 | 211 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 13 | Presbyteriumsordnung [1609] | 1609 | 10, p. 504 | 211 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Konventsordnung [1609] | 1609 | 10, p. 515 | 211 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 15 | Predigtmandat 1609 | 1609 | 10, p. 529 | 211 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 16 | Konsistoriumsordnung 1612 | 1612 | 10, p. 531 | 211 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 17 | Anstellungsrevers für die Geistlichen 1614 | 1614 | 10, p. 541 | 211 | Appointment / oath | R | |

### 1.18.5 County of Ysenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Ronneburg-Kelsterbach Reformed 1584-1597; Birstein Reformed from 1596; Ronneburg-Ronneburg Reformed from 1601.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 18, Reformed 12.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1544 | 1544 | 10, p. 569 | 216 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung für die Stadt Büdingen 1553 | 1553 | 10, p. 572 | 217 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Agende [1582] | 1582 | 10, p. 574 | 218 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Erneuerung der Kirchenordnung 1587 | 1587 | 10, p. 585 | 219 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenbußagende [1587] | 1587 | 10, p. 588 | 220 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6 | Fastnachtsmandat 1590 | 1590 | 10, p. 593 | 221 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 7 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1591 | 1591 | 10, p. 594 | 222 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 8 | Memorial zur Kirchenzuchtordnung 1592 | 1592 | 10, p. 600 | 223 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 9 | Abendmahlsmandat 1549 | 1549 | 10, p. 604 | 224 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 10 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1557 | 1557 | 10, p. 605 | 225 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 11 | Mandat gegen Inzest, Vergewaltigung und Ehebruch 1582 | 1582 | 10, p. 613 | 226 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12 | Sittenzuchtordnung 1584 | 1584 | 10, p. 615 | 226 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | Auftrag zur Formulierung einer Kirchenordnung 1586 | 1586 | 10, p. 617 | 227 | Church order | L | |
| 14 | Kirchenordnung 1588 | 1588 | 10, p. 618 | 228 | Church order | L | |
| 15 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1588 | 1588 | 10, p. 637 | 229 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 16 | Mandat zur Kirchenordnung 1588 | 1588 | 10, p. 643 | 230 | Church order | L | |
| 17 | Kirchenordnung 1598 | 1598 | 10, p. 644 | 231 | Church order | R | |
| 18 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1598 | 1598 | 10, p. 670 | 232 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 19 | Visitationsordnung [1598] | 1598 | 10, p. 679 | 233 | Visitation | R | |
| 20 | Konsistoriumsordnung 1608 | 1608 | 10, p. 683 | 234 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 21 | Almosenordnung für die Stadt Büdingen 1611 | 1611 | 10, p. 689 | 235 | Poor relief | R | |
| 22 | Fastnachtsmandat 1612 | 1612 | 10, p. 693 | 236 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 23 | Mandat zur Belehrung der Gemeinden über den Katholizismus 1614 | 1614 | 10, p. 694 | 237 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 24 | Mandat zum evangelischen Sonntagsgebet 1614 | 1614 | 10, p. 696 | 238 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 25 | Kirchenordnung 1580 | 1580 | 10, p. 698 | 239 | Church order | R | |
| 26 | Ehemandat [1580] | 1580 | 10, p. 701 | 239 | Marriage | L | |
| 27 | Kirchen- und Sittenzuchtordnung [1581]/1587 | 1587 | 10, p. 703 | 239 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 28 | Ordnung gegen Ehebruch und Hurerei 1584 | 1584 | 10, p. 710 | 239 | Marriage | L | |
| 29 | Edikt gegen Unzucht und Ehebruch 1584 | 1584 | 10, p. 714 | 239 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 30 | Mandat zur Einschärfung des Edikts gegen Unzucht und Ehebruch [1584] | 1584 | 10, p. 718 | 239 | Mandate / decree | L | |

## 1.19 Volume 11: Bavaria I: Franconia (Nuremberg, Ansbach-Kulmbach, imperial cities)

64 texts.

### 1.19.1 Imperial city of Nuremberg (to 1528)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Eins Rats der Stat Nürmberg ordnung des grossen allmusens Haußarmer leut 1522 | 1522 | 11, p. 23 | 244 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Ordnug, wie man tauffet, bisher im latein gehalten, verteütscht. 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 33 | 245 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Messe des Priors Volprecht. 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 39 | 247 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Artikel, der sich die beeden pröbst ... verglichen haben ... 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 44 | 247 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 5 | Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 46 | 249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6 | Von der evangelischen meß ... zu Nürnberg im Newen Spital durch Andream Döber ... 1525 | 1525 | 11, p. 51 | 249 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Form und ordnung eyner Christlichen Meß zu Nürmberg im Newen Spital 1525 | 1525 | 11, p. 56 | 250 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Einlaitunge der Eheleut 1526 | 1526 | 11, p. 58 | 252 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.19.2 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (to 1528)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ein cristenliche Ordenung der Betler halben ...in der Stat Kitzingen ... 1523 | 1523 | 11, p. 72 | 253 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Dorffmayster ...zu Wendelstains fürhalten jrem new angeendem Pfarrherrn gethan. 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 77 | 254 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 3 | Handlung und beschluß, des ... Fürsten Casimir, ... mit sampt seinen gaistlichen Prelaten und hochgelerten, das Gotswort betreffent. ... 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 80 | 255 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525 | 1525 | 11, p. 82 | 257 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 5 | Der ... Marggraven zu Brandenburg ... anzeigen, wie ... durch ... prediger vil aufrur fürkummen werden mög. Auch ein kurze ... underricht, wie ... | 1525 | 11, p. 84 | 257 | Other | L | |
| 6 | Abschied, ... wes sich ... Herr Casimir ... bis auf ein zukünftig Nacionalversammlung, ... in jrer Gnaden Land ... zu halten vereynigt haben. [1526.] | 1526 | 11, p. 88 | 258 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 7 | Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.] | 1526 | 11, p. 98 | 260 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Abschied des ... Fürsten, ... herrn Geörgen ... mit ... gemeiner Landschafft ... 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 102 | 260 | Treaty / agreement | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Mandat zur Durchführung der Reformation. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 105 | 262 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 10 | Mandat über Pfründenbesetzung. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 106 | 263 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Der evangelische Priestereid. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 107 | 264 | Appointment / oath | L | |

#### 1.19.3 Brandenburg and Nuremberg together (1528-1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Die Ansbacher 30 Fragen. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 126 | 267 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 128 | 267 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 3 | Die brandenburgisch-nürnbergischeKirchenordnung von 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 135 | 269 | Church order | L | |
| 4a | Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Kirchenordnung ... 1533 | 1533 | 11, p. 140 | 269 | Church order | L | |
| 4b | Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Catechismus oder Kinderpredig. 1533 | 1533 | 11, p. 206 | 270 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 4c | Ansbacher Landtagsabschied 1525: Brandenburgische Nachträge. 1533 | 1533 | 11, p. 279 | 271 | Other | L | |

#### 1.19.4 Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach (from 1528/1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Gottesdienstmandat 1531 | 1531 | 11, p. 306 | 275 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Ordnung singens und lesens bei den stiften. 1533 | 1533 | 11, p. 311 | 275 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenvisitation im Markgraftum Brandenburg unter dem Gebirg. 1536 | 1536 | 11, p. 317 | 277 | Visitation | L | |
| 4 | Mehrung der vorigen kirchenordnung. 1548 | 1548 | 11, p. 325 | 277 | Church order | L | **Interim order**; the 'Auctuarium', Brandenburg-Ansbach's adaptation of its order to the Interim |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Wassertrüdinger Kapitelsordnung. 1545 | 1545 | 11, p. 332 | 279 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode 1556 | 1556 | 11, p. 335 | 280 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7a | Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.]: Synodalordnung von 1556 | 1556 | 11, p. 338 | 281 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7b | Ordnung der Tauff nach wirtzburgischer Rubricken von wort und wort verteutscht. [1526.]: Schreiben an die Amtmänner | 1526 | 11, p. 341 | 281 | Other | L | |
| 8 | Visitationsvermahnung im Oberland. 1558 | 1558 | 11, p. 344 | 282 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9 | Kapitelsordnung von 1565/1578 | 1578 | 11, p. 346 | 283 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 10 | Gewalt zur specialvisitation. 1565 | 1565 | 11, p. 360 | 283 | Visitation | L | |
| 11 | Übertragung der Kapitelsordnung auf das Oberland. 1572 | 1572 | 11, p. 362 | 285 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 12 | Errichtung eines Ehegerichts in Ansbach. 1556 | 1556 | 11, p. 364 | 286 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 13 | Gerichtsstand der Geistlichen. 1565 | 1565 | 11, p. 365 | 287 | Other | L | |
| 14 | Eheartikel vom 10. Juni 1565 bzw. 10. Juni 1573 | 1573 | 11, p. 367 | 288 | Marriage | L | |
| 15 | Ehegerichtsordnung und Errichtung des Konsistoriums zu Kulmbach vom 18. Okt. 1567 | 1567 | 11, p. 371 | 289 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 16 | Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570 | 1570 | 11, p. 377 | 290 | Other | L | |
| 17 | Konsistorialordnung von 1594 | 1594 | 11, p. 379 | 291 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 18 | Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen und in den schulen anzurichten. 1538 | 1538 | 11, p. 397 | 292 | School / university | L | |
| 19 | Verzeichnüs, wie es in beden kirchen alhie zue Feuchtwang | 1563 | 11, p. 399 | 293 | Other | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | gehalten würd. 1563 | | | | | | |
| 20 | Ordo ecclesiasticus in Hof von Enoch Widmann. 1592 | 1592 | 11, p. 405 | 293 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.19.5 Imperial city of Nuremberg (from 1533)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Agendbüchlein für die Pfarrherrn auff dem Land. Durch Vitum Dietrich. 1545 | 1545 | 11, p. 487 | 296 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Vermanung ..., die ein Pfarrherr ... jerlich ... vorlesen ..., welcher gestalt sich sein pfarrvolck, in empfahung des Heyligen Sacraments, und dann ... | 1558 | 11, p. 554 | 297 | Other | L | |
| 3 | Mandat wider die Hurerei. 1582 | 1582 | 11, p. 557 | 299 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.19.6 Imperial city of Rothenburg ob der Tauber

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ordnung der Kirchen in eines Erbarn Raths der Stat Rothenburg uf der Tauber Oberkeit und gebiet gelegen. 1559 | 1559 | 11, p. 566 | 300 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Instruction, wie die Kirchenordnung gehandhabt und vollzogen werden soll. 1558 | 1558 | 11, p. 599 | 302 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.19.7 Imperial city of Schweinfurt with Gochsheim and Sennfeld

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung Eines Erbarn Raths des heiligen Reichs Stat Schweinfurt. ...1543 | 1543 | 11, p. 624 | 303 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Ordnung, wie es an den sontagen und festtagen alhie zu Schweinfurt ... sol gehalten ... werden. 1576 | 1576 | 11, p. 645 | 304 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 3 | Dorfordnung für Gochsheim und Sennfeld. 1543 | 1543 | 11, p. 649 | 306 | Other | L | |

#### 1.19.8 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Franconia)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ein ... auszug ... der ordnung in dem gottesdienst bei der christlichen gemain zu Weißenburg. 1528 | 1528 | 11, p. 657 | 307 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Ungefärlicher begriff des kirchenregiments ordnung und bestellung (um 1590) | 1590 | 11, p. 665 | 308 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.19.9 Imperial city of Windsheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Ordnung, wie es nun hinfüro mit dem gefelle dies gemeinen castens ... gehalten werden soll. 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 674 | 312 | Local order | L | |

#### 1.19.10 County of Castell

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Dorfsordnung, ... in ... Obereisensheim ... 1579 | 1579 | 11, p. 684 | 314 | Other | L | |

#### 1.19.11 County of Rieneck

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ulmers Gottesdienstform. 1544 | 1544 | 11, p. 698 | 317 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Vesperordnung zu Lohr. 1588 | 1588 | 11, p. 699 | 318 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.19.12 County of Wertheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Wertheimer Kirchenordnung von 1524 | 1524 | 11, p. 707 | 322 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Wertheimer Kirchenordnung um 1555 | 1555 | 11, p. 708 | 323 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.19.13 Lordship of Thüngen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Thüngenische Kirchenordnung. 1564 | 1564 | 11, p. 731 | 326 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Lectiones sacrae in Burgsinn. 1587 | 1587 | 11, p. 743 | 327 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.20 Volume 12: Bavaria II: Swabia (Augsburg and the Swabian imperial cities)

46 texts.

### 1.20.1 Imperial city of Augsburg

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed, save Rhegius's baptism rite (no. 3, Lutheran); Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwinglian-Bucerian) until the Interim; Lutheran after 1552/1555. Rhegius's baptism rite is coded by its author, from 1531 superintendent of the Lutheran church at Celle.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 13, Lutheran 4.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Priesterhochzeit 1523 | 1523 | 12, p. 33 | 333 | Marriage | MR | |
| 2 | Das frugebet, so man anstatt der bäpstischen meß haltet | 1529 | 12, p. 35 | 333 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | dated by the editor: oldest edition 1529 |
| 3 | Taufritus des Urban Rhegius | n.d. | 12, p. 39 | 333 | Agenda / liturgy | L | between 1524 and 1530, when Rhegius was the city's preacher; coded by its author |
| 4 | Form und Ordnung des Herrn nachtmal betreffend 1530 | 1530 | 12, p. 40 | 334 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 5 | Reformationsmandat vom 29. Juli 1534 | 1534 | 12, p. 44 | 335 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 6 | Bestallung eines Predigers 1535 | 1535 | 12, p. 46 | 336 | Appointment / oath | MR | |
| 7 | Dekret über die Wochengottesdienste vom 9. Juni 1537 | 1537 | 12, p. 49 | 337 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 8a | Kirchenordnung von 1537 | 1537 | 12, p. 50 | 338 | Church order | MR | |
| 8b | Auszug aus der Kirchenordnung | 1537 | 12, p. 65 | 338 | Church order | MR | dated by the editor: the summary of the church order of 1537, laid before the council with it |
| 9 | Die zehen gebot, Articul des Glaubens, Und das Vater unser... (1537) | 1537 | 12, p. 67 | 338 | Other | MR | |
| 10 | Forma, wie von dem hailigen Tauf, und dem hailigen Sacrament des leibs und bluts Christ,... vom Elichen Stand... zu reden sey... 1537 | 1537 | 12, p. 72 | 338 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| | II. Feiertagsordnung vom 22. Juli 1537 | 1537 | 12, p. 84 | 339 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 12 | Forma. Wie vom hailigen Tauf, und dem H. Sacrament des Leibs und Bluts Christi... vom Eelichen Stand... zu reden sei... (1545) | 1545 | 12, p. 85 | 339 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 | Gottesdienstformen um 1548 | 1548 | 12, p. 93 | 340 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 14 | Forma. Wie vom hailigen tauf, und dem hailigen Sacrament des leibs und Bluts Christi... von dem trost der Kranken... vom Ehlichen Stand... zureden ... | 1555 | 12, p. 95 | 340 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 15 | Vergleichartikel von 1591 | 1591 | 12, p. 109 | 341 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 16 | Einzelbestimmungen zu den Berufungsverhandlungen 1591 | 1591 | 12, p. 112 | 342 | Appointment / oath | L | |

### 1.20.2 Imperial city of Dinkelsbühl

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kapitelsordnung 1535 | 1535 | 12, p. 126 | 346 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 2 | Bestallungsurkunde des Predigers Konrad Abel 1542 | 1542 | 12, p. 128 | 347 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenpflegeordnung 1574 | 1574 | 12, p. 131 | 348 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 4 | Generalbestallung auf alle und jede helfer... 1573 | 1573 | 12, p. 134 | 348 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 5 | Revers des helfers | n.d. | 12, p. 141 | 348 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 6 | Wes man sich in aufnemung und bestellung eines vorsingers verhalten soll | n.d. | 12, p. 142 | 348 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7 | Warhaftige copi der vom rat ubergebnen form, darauf die kirchendiener angelobt haben | n.d. | 12, p. 144 | 348 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Fragstueck, darauf alle pfarrer... gefragt werden sollen | n.d. | 12, p. 145 | 348 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Bericht, wie man es halten soll | n.d. | 12, p. 146 | 348 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.20.3 Imperial city of Donauwörth

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung von Donauwörth 1545 | 1545 | 12, p. 158 | 351 | Church order | L | |

### 1.20.4 Imperial city of Kempten

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Primus Trubers Kirchenordnung 1553 | 1553 | 12, p. 175 | 354 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.20.5 Imperial city of Lindau

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: A Tetrapolitan city (Upper German) until the Interim; Lutheran afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Zuchtordnung von 1533 | 1533 | 12, p. 186 | 357 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 2 | Bekanntmachungen zur Einschärfung der Zuchtordnung (Lasterstraf) 1539 | 1539 | 12, p. 198 | 358 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 3 | Almusenordnung in der statt Lindaw 1533 | 1533 | 12, p. 200 | 359 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 4 | Agenda,... wie es... in der Pfarrkirchen zu Lindaw... 1573 | 1573 | 12, p. 203 | 360 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Agenda, wie es auf dem land... zu Rüte und Eschach... (1573) | 1573 | 12, p. 218 | 361 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.20.6 Imperial city of Memmingen

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: A Tetrapolitan city (Upper German) until the Interim; Lutheran afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 4, Lutheran 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung von 1528 | 1528 | 12, p. 223 | 363 | Church order | MR | |
| 2 | Ordnung und Brauch deß Herrennachtmals... (1529) | 1529 | 12, p. 239 | 364 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3 | Zuchtordnung von 1532 | 1532 | 12, p. 247 | 365 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnung... 1569 | 1569 | 12, p. 256 | 366 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Meßpfründenordnung 1542 | 1542 | 12, p. 267 | 367 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |

#### 1.20.7 Imperial city of Nördlingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Von der Evangelischen Mesß... Durch Caspar Kantz... (1522) | 1522 | 12, p. 285 | 369 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Renovatio Ecclesiae Nordlingiacensis... 1525 | 1525 | 12, p. 289 | 370 | Other | L | |
| 3 | Der statt Nordling... reformation und kirchenordnung... 1538 | 1538 | 12, p. 307 | 371 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners 1544 | 1544 | 12, p. 310 | 372 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen..., gestelt durch M. Caspar Löhner... 1544, und jetzo wider ubersehen ... durch Melchior ... | 1555 | 12, p. 317 | 373 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6 | Nördlinger Superintendenzordnung 1564 | 1564 | 12, p. 330 | 374 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 7 | Kirchenordnung von 1579 | 1579 | 12, p. 335 | 375 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.20.8 County of Oettingen-Oettingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Visitationsordnung 1591 | 1591 | 12, p. 403 | 378 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.21 Volume 13: Bavaria III: Altbayern (Pfalz-Neuburg, Upper Palatinate, Regensburg)

82 texts.

#### 1.21.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Neuburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reformationsmandat vom 22.Juni 1542 | 1542 | 13, p. 39 | 385 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnungen von 1543 | 1543 | 13, p. 41 | 386 | Church order | L | |
| 2a | Der erste teil der kirchenordnung. Von der lehre insgemein | n.d. | 13, p. 44 | 386 | Church order | L | |
| 2b | Der ander teil der kirchenordnung. Von den heiligen sacramenten und andern christlichen ceremonien | n.d. | 13, p. 46 | 386 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2c | Der dritte teil der kirchenordnung. Catechismus | n.d. | 13, p. 98 | 386 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Die geänderte Taufordnung. 1543 | 1543 | 13, p. 100 | 387 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Bekanntmachung der Bestallung eines Superintendenten vom 16. Nov. 1545 | 1545 | 13, p. 103 | 388 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung. 1554 | 1554 | 13, p. 104 | 389 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Verordnung zur Beseitigung der Bilder und Feldkapellen vom 12. Aug. 1555 | 1555 | 13, p. 106 | 390 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Bekanntmachung einer Superintendentenbestallung vom 17. April 1555 | 1555 | 13, p. 107 | 391 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Bestallung eines Pfarrers vom 10. März 1555 | 1555 | 13, p. 108 | 392 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 9 | Revers eines Pfarrers vom 11. März 1555 | 1555 | 13, p. 110 | 393 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 10 | Zuchtordnung gegenüber den Geistlichen vom 16. Febr. 1556 | 1556 | 13, p. 111 | 394 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 11 | Edikt über Eheordnung, Sonntagsheiligung und gegen verschiedene Laster vom 8. Nov. 1555 | 1555 | 13, p. 114 | 395 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12 | Verordnung gegen die Wiedertäufer vom 9. Mai 1558 | 1558 | 13, p. 117 | 396 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 13 | Visitationsordnung vom 23. Aug. 1558 | 1558 | 13, p. 120 | 397 | Visitation | L | |
| 14 | Kirchenordnung vom 2. Jan. 1560 | 1560 | 13, p. 125 | 398 | Church order | L | |
| 15 | Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566 | 1566 | 13, p. 128 | 399 | Visitation | L | |
| 15a | Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566: Instruktion | 1566 | 13, p. 128 | 399 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15b | Visitationsinstruktion vom 28. Juni 1560 sowie vom 16. Nov. 1566: Beilagen | 1566 | 13, p. 138 | 399 | Other | L | |
| 16 | Superintendenturordnung vom 6. Dez. 1562 | 1562 | 13, p. 142 | 400 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 17 | Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten vom 1. Juni 1564 | 1564 | 13, p. 147 | 401 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | Kirchenordnung vom 19. Nov. 1570 | 1570 | 13, p. 151 | 402 | Church order | L | |
| 19 | Visitationsinstruktion vom 9. April 1576 | 1576 | 13, p. 163 | 403 | Visitation | L | |
| 20 | Generalartikel vom 20. Febr. 1576 | 1576 | 13, p. 168 | 404 | Visitation | L | |
| 21 | Konsistorialordnung vom 7. Juni 1576 | 1576 | 13, p. 236 | 405 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 22 | Eheordnung vom 2. Jan. 1577 | 1577 | 13, p. 241 | 406 | Marriage | L | |
| 23 | Prüfungsordnung vom 13. Mai 1577 | 1577 | 13, p. 249 | 407 | Other | L | |

#### 1.21.2 Upper Palatinate (Electoral Palatinate)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1559; Lutheran from 1577; Reformed from 1583.
- **Note**: Lutheran under Ottheinrich; Friedrich III's Calvinizing (from 1559) was resisted; Ludwig VI restored Lutheranism (1577); Reformed again from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 13, Lutheran 9.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Amberg, Spitalgottesdienst. 1544 | 1544 | 13, p. 282 | 410 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Bericht des Predigers Dr. Faber vom 29. Nov. 1550 über die Kirchenordnung in Amberg | 1550 | 13, p. 285 | 411 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung Amberg. 1555/1557 | 1557 | 13, p. 288 | 411 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Visitationsordnung vom 15. Febr. 1557 | 1557 | 13, p. 295 | 413 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Amberger Vier Punkte vom 9. Dezember 1566 | 1566 | 13, p. 298 | 414 | Other | R | |
| 6 | Amberger Mandat vom 20. Jan. 1567 | 1567 | 13, p. 303 | 415 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 7 | Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579 | 1579 | 13, p. 305 | 416 | Visitation | L | |
| 7a | Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Offen Patent | 1579 | 13, p. 305 | 416 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7b | Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Instruktion | 1579 | 13, p. 306 | 416 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7c | Visitationsordnung vom 10. (16.) Aug. 1579: Interrogatoria | 1579 | 13, p. 314 | 416 | Other | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8 | Einführung von Senioren. 1581 | 1581 | 13, p. 319 | 417 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Einschärfung verschiedener Mandate gegen Laster und kirchliche Mißstände vom Juni 1584 | 1584 | 13, p. 320 | 418 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 10 | Mandatum de non calumniando vom 24. Nov. 1584 | 1584 | 13, p. 325 | 419 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 11 | Kirchenratsinstruktion vom 3. März 1585 | 1585 | 13, p. 328 | 420 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 12 | Kurfürstliche Erklärung an die Landstände vom 18. März 1592 | 1592 | 13, p. 331 | 421 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 13 | Neumarkter Mandat vom 8. April 1592 | 1592 | 13, p. 334 | 422 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 14 | Amberger Rezeß vom 8. Juni 1593 | 1593 | 13, p. 336 | 423 | Other | R | |
| 15 | Institutionswerk vom 6. Juli 1596 | 1596 | 13, p. 338 | 424 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 16 | Ordnung, darnach sich kirchen- und schuldiener der statt Amberg hinfort richten sollen. Vom 9. Dez. 1597 | 1597 | 13, p. 341 | 425 | School / university | R | |
| 17 | Befehl über den Gerichtsstand der Geistlichen in der Oberpfalz vom 7. Febr. 1598 | 1598 | 13, p. 345 | 426 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 18 | Generalanweisung vom 20. März 1598 | 1598 | 13, p. 346 | 427 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 19 | Presbyterii Ordnung vom 7. Aug. 1615 | 1615 | 13, p. 352 | 428 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |

#### 1.21.3 Imperial city of Regensburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Wahrhaftiger Bericht eines Rats der Stadt Regensburg über die Einsetzung des Abendmahls. 10. Okt. 1542 | 1542 | 13, p. 389 | 431 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Aufrichtung der wahren Religion. 14. Okt. 1542 | 1542 | 13, p. 394 | 433 | Other | L | |
| 3 | Vermahnung vor der Beichte | n.d. | 13, p. 395 | 434 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | Kirchenordnung des Noppus. 1543 | 1543 | 13, p. 406 | 436 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Ordnung des Abendmahls und der Vesper. 1543 | 1543 | 13, p. 412 | 436 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Vermahnung ... wider etliche Laster vom 16. Aug. 1543 | 1543 | 13, p. 414 | 437 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Errichtung eines Konsistoriums vom 23. Juni 1545 | 1545 | 13, p. 416 | 438 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 9 | Bußvermahnung wegen des Verhaltens während des Interims vom 22. Juni 1552 | 1552 | 13, p. 417 | 439 | Agenda / liturgy | L | **After the Interim** |
| 10 | Kirchenordnung des Justus Jonas. 1553 | 1553 | 13, p. 419 | 440 | Church order | L | |
| 11 | Gottesdienstverteilung. 1553 | 1553 | 13, p. 428 | 441 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 12 | Ordinationsordnung. 1553 | 1553 | 13, p. 429 | 442 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 13 | Warum die Leviten- und Meßgewand sollen abgetan werden, den Kirchen fürzutragen, vom 29. April 1554 | 1554 | 13, p. 432 | 443 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 14 | Ordnung der Kirchendiener [1553?] | 1553 | 13, p. 434 | 445 | Church order | L | |
| 15 | Ordnung in Sterbsläuften. 21. Sept. 1562 | 1562 | 13, p. 435 | 446 | Local order | L | |
| | Nachtrag vom 31. Juli 1563 | 1563 | 13, p. 437 | 446 | Other | L | |
| 16 | Kirchenregimentsordnung vom 9. März 1556 | 1556 | 13, p. 438 | 447 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 17 | Vergleichsartikel mit Gallus vom 14. März 1560 | 1560 | 13, p. 446 | 448 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 18 | Verbot des Disputierens vom 1. Juli 1566 | 1566 | 13, p. 450 | 449 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 19 | Kirchenordnung des Gallus (um 1567) | 1567 | 13, p. 452 | 450 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Vermahnung vor der Kommunion | n.d. | 13, p. 463 | 450 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 20 | Kanzelabkündigung über das Verfahren bei Kirchenzucht vom 20. Febr. 1576 | 1576 | 13, p. 490 | 451 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | Kirchenregimentsordnung vom 2. Aug. 1572 und vom 12. April 1588 | 1588 | 13, p. 493 | 452 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| | Nachtrag vom 9. Febr. 1599 | 1599 | 13, p. 510 | 452 | Other | L | |
| 22 | Konsistorialordnung vom 19. Jan. 1588 | 1588 | 13, p. 512 | 453 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

#### 1.21.4 County of Ortenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reformationsmandat vom 25. Old. 1563 | 1563 | 13, p. 529 | 456 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Gottesdienstordnung. 1563 | 1563 | 13, p. 531 | 457 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Bestallung des Pfarrers Pflacher vom 19. Febr. 1573 bzw. 1578 | 1578 | 13, p. 533 | 458 | Appointment / oath | L | |

#### 1.21.5 Lordship of Rothenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Pfarrereid vom 5. Nov. 1601 | 1601 | 13, p. 545 | 460 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung vom 30. Okt. 1618 | 1618 | 13, p. 547 | 460 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Ordinationsordnung vom 9. Nov. 1618 | 1618 | 13, p. 558 | 461 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.21.6 Lordship of Wolfstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung. 1574 | 1574 | 13, p. 566 | 462 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Eheordnung (um 1574) | 1574 | 13, p. 593 | 463 | Marriage | L | |

### 1.22 Volume 14: Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)

110 texts.

#### 1.22.1 Electoral Palatinate (Kurpfalz)

- **Tradition**: by reign (see note).

- **Note**: Lutheran under Friedrich II and Ottheinrich; Reformed under Friedrich III (1563 order); Lutheran under Ludwig VI (1576-1583), while his brother Johann Casimir kept the Reformed order in Pfalz-Lautern (nos. 78-79); Reformed again from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 67, Lutheran 43.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 25 | [Mandat gegen das Unmaß bei Hochzeiten und Banketten vom 12. Dezember 1561] | 1561 | 14, p. 35 | 468 | Marriage | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 28 | Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [für die Oberpfalz vom 12. Juli 1563] | 1563 | 14, p. 36 | 468 | Marriage | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 34 | Form, wie das heilig nachtmahl unsers herrn und heilands Jesu Christi sampt der vorbereitung in der kirchen zu Heidelberg und anderen kirchen der … | 1564 | 14, p. 49 | 468 | Agenda / liturgy | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 37 | Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [von 1565] | 1565 | 14, p. 50 | 468 | Discipline / police | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 38 | Pfaltzgrave Friderichs churfürstliche, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [von 1565] | 1565 | 14, p. 50 | 468 | Marriage | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 39 | Kirchenordnung … [von 1565] | 1565 | 14, p. 50 | 468 | Church order | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 42 | Kirchenordnung … [von 1567] | 1567 | 14, p. 52 | 468 | Church order | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 43 | Kirchenordnung … [von 1569] | 1569 | 14, p. 52 | 468 | Church order | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 53 | Pfalntzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., und Marggrave Philipsen zu Baden etc. aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung in der gemeinschaft … | 1572 | 14, p. 56 | 468 | Discipline / police | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 57 | Mandat und constitution … [für Oberpfalz vom 11. August 1575] | 1575 | 14, p. 58 | 468 | Mandate / decree | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich III |
| 59 | [Bestallung eines Glöckners vom 20. April 1577] | 1577 | 14, p. 62 | 468 | Appointment / oath | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 60 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, administrierung der heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen … | 1577 | 14, p. 63 | 468 | Church order | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 61 | [Kirchenratsordnung von etwa 1577] | 1577 | 14, p. 65 | 468 | Consistory / synod / | L | described in the introduction only; |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | | government | | Ludwig VI |
| 62 | Pfaltzgrave Ludwigs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [vom 1. Januar 1578] | 1578 | 14, p. 66 | 468 | Discipline / police | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 63 | Pfalntzgrave Ludwigs, churfürstens etc., und bischof Marquards zu Speir etc. aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung in der gemeynschaft Altenstatt … | 1578 | 14, p. 66 | 468 | Discipline / police | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 64 | Mandat und constitution ... [für Oberpfalz vom 19. September 1579] | 1579 | 14, p. 68 | 468 | Mandate / decree | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 65 | Mandat und constitution ... [für Rheinpfalz vom 26. September 1579] | 1579 | 14, p. 68 | 468 | Mandate / decree | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 68 | [Christliche Polizeiordnung vom 4. April 1582] | 1582 | 14, p. 69 | 468 | Discipline / police | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 69 | [Christliche Almosenordnung vom 4. April 1582] | 1582 | 14, p. 69 | 468 | Poor relief | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 70 | Pfaltzgraf Ludwigs churfürstens und hertzog Reichards, pfaltzgrafen etc., deßgleichen marggrafe Philipsen zu Baden etc., aufgerichte christliche … | 1582 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Discipline / police | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 71 | [Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung vom 3. September 1582] | 1582 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 72 | Mandat und constitution ... [vom 3. September 1582] | 1582 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Mandate / decree | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 73 | Mandat und constitution ... [von 1583] | 1583 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Mandate / decree | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 74 | [ Christliche Polizeiordnung von 1583] | 1583 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Discipline / police | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 75 | [Christliche Almosenordnung von 1583] | 1583 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Poor relief | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 76 | [ Christliche Eheordnung von 1583] | 1583 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Marriage | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |
| 77 | Mandat und constitution ... [von 1583] | 1583 | 14, p. 70 | 468 | Mandate / decree | L | described in the introduction only; Ludwig VI |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 78 | Kirchenordnung ... [von 1576/1577] | 1577 | 14, p. 72 | 468 | Church order | R | described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern |
| 79 | Des durchleuchtigen, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Johann Casimirs, pfaltzgrafen bey Rhein, hertzogen in Bayern etc., christliche eheordnung ... | 1578 | 14, p. 73 | 468 | Marriage | R | described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern |
| 81 | Mandat und constitution ... [vom 17. Mai 1585] | 1585 | 14, p. 77 | 468 | Mandate / decree | R | described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 82 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in der chur- und fürstlichen Pfaltz bey Rhein gehalten wirdt. ... | 1585 | 14, p. 77 | 468 | Church order | R | described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 88 | [Bestallung eines Glöckners, zwischen 1583 und 1592] | 1592 | 14, p. 81 | 468 | Appointment / oath | R | described in the introduction only; Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 89 | Mandat und constitution ... [für Oberpfalz vom 8. Januar 1593] | 1593 | 14, p. 83 | 468 | Mandate / decree | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 90 | [Revers und Bestallung eines Kirchenrats vom 1. Mai 1593] | 1593 | 14, p. 83 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 92 | [ Christliche Polizeiordnung von 1594] | 1594 | 14, p. 84 | 468 | Discipline / police | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 93 | [Christliche Almosenordnung von 1594] | 1594 | 14, p. 84 | 468 | Poor relief | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 94 | [Christliche Almosenordnung für Oberpfalz von 1599] | 1599 | 14, p. 84 | 468 | Poor relief | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 95 | Churfürstlicher Pfaltz verneuerte almusenordnunge und, was deren anhanget [vom 12. Januar 1600] | 1600 | 14, p. 85 | 468 | Poor relief | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 99 | [Bestallung eines Inspektors vom 22. Juli 1601] | 1601 | 14, p. 86 | 468 | Appointment / oath | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 101 | [ Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung für Oberpfalz von 1606] | 1606 | 14, p. 87 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 102 | Mandat und constitution ... [für Oberpfalz von 1606] | 1606 | 14, p. 87 | 468 | Mandate / decree | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 104 | Bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in der Obern churfürstlichen Pfaltz in Bayern zum kirchendienst aufgenommen wird, mit handgegebener treu an ... | 1609 | 14, p. 88 | 468 | School / university | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 105 | Bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in der ObernchurfürstlichenPfaltz in Bayern zum schuldienst aufgenommen wird, mit handgegebener treu an ... | 1609 | 14, p. 88 | 468 | School / university | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 106 | [ Christliche Ehe- und Ehegerichtsordnung vom 11. Juli 1610] | 1610 | 14, p. 88 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 107 | Mandat und constitution ... [vom 11. Juli 1610] | 1610 | 14, p. 88 | 468 | Mandate / decree | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich IV |
| 108 | Churfürstlicher Pfaltz kirchendienerbestallungspuncten [von 1610] | 1610 | 14, p. 89 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich V |
| 109 | Churfürstlicher Pfaltz schuldienerbestallungspuncten [von 1610] | 1610 | 14, p. 89 | 468 | School / university | R | described in the introduction only; Friedrich V |
| 110 | Ordnung gewisser zusammenkunften der kirchendiener (classici conventus genant), wie es damit in dieser Obern churfürstlichen Pfaltz gehalten werden ... | 1615 | 14, p. 89 | 468 | Consistory / synod / government | R | described in the introduction only |
| 1 | [Edikt über die fakultative Reichung des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt, Abhaltung des Gottesdienstes und Reichung der Sakramente in deutscher ... | 1546 | 14, p. 90 | 469 | Agenda / liturgy | L | Friedrich II |
| 2 | Bedenken des durchleuchtigsten pfaltzgraven Friederichs, churfursten und meins gnedigsten herren auf trefflich gehalten rathe seyner churfürstlichen ... | 1546 | 14, p. 90 | 469 | Mandate / decree | L | Friedrich II |
| 3 | Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten, biß das hierin durch kunftige visitatores und superattendenten weiter bericht gegeben würde ... | 1546 | 14, p. 94 | 472 | Visitation | L | Friedrich II |
| 4 | Pfaltzgrave Friedrichs, churfürsten etc., aufgerichtete ordenunge christlicher und guter policey [vom 17. Juni 1546] | 1546 | 14, p. 102 | 473 | Discipline / police | L | Friedrich II |
| 5 | Kirchenordnu[n]g, wie es mit der christlichen lehr, heiligen sacramenten und | 1547 | 14, p. 109 | 473 | Church order | L | Friedrich II |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | allerley andern ceremonien in meines gnedigen herrn, herrn … | | | | | | |
| 6 | [Reformationsmandat an die Amtleute, betreffend die Abschaffung des katholischen Gottesdiensts und vorläufige Ordnung des Gottesdiensts im … | 1556 | 14, p. 111 | 474 | Agenda / liturgy | L | Ottheinrich |
| 7 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen leere, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herren … | 1556 | 14, p. 113 | 476 | Church order | L | Ottheinrich |
| 8 | Von den eesachen, wie dieselbige in des durchleuchtigisten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, hern Ottheinrichs, pfaltzgraven bey Rhein, des heiligen … | n.d. | 14, p. 221 | 481 | Marriage | L | Ottheinrich |
| 9 | Schulordnung, wie dieselbige in des durchleuchtigisten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, hern Ottheinrichs, pfaltzgraven bey Rhein, des heiligen … | n.d. | 14, p. 225 | 482 | School / university | L | Ottheinrich |
| 10 | [Instruktion der Kirchenräte von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 229 | 484 | Mandate / decree | L | Ottheinrich |
| 11 | [Instruktion der Spezialsuperintendenten von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 231 | 485 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 12 | [Instruktion der Generalsuperintendenten von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 233 | 486 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 13 | De electione et examine ministrorum ecclesiae [von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 234 | 486 | Other | L | Ottheinrich |
| 14 | [Bedenken des Superintendenten über Schwenckfeldianer, Wiedertäufer und andere Sekten von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 236 | 486 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 15 | [Bedenken der Verordneten und Generalsuperintendenten über das Verfahren mit trunksüchtigen Kirchendienern von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 239 | 486 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 16 | [Form der Einführung von Kirchendienern von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 241 | 486 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 17 | Folgen etliche nebenbedengken, wie es in andern sachen bey den kirchen und pfharhen, sonderlich mit den gemainen, auch armenkasten, gehalten mocht … | 1556 | 14, p. 243 | 487 | Poor relief | L | Ottheinrich |
| 18 | [Visitationsinstruktion von 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 246 | 488 | Visitation | L | Ottheinrich |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | [Mandat auf die gehaltene Visitation vom 22. Dezember 1556] | 1556 | 14, p. 252 | 489 | Visitation | L | Ottheinrich |
| 20 | [Mandat über die Entfernung der Bilder und Nebenaltäre aus den Kirchen von 1557] | 1557 | 14, p. 254 | 490 | Mandate / decree | L | Ottheinrich |
| 21 | [Erneuerung des Bildermandats vom 14. Dezember 1557] | 1557 | 14, p. 255 | 491 | Mandate / decree | L | Ottheinrich |
| 22 | [Revers und Bestallungsbrief eines Kirchendieners vom Januar 1558] | 1558 | 14, p. 256 | 492 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 23 | Instruction, weß sich unser pfaltzgrave Ottheinrichs, churfurstens etc., geordenter specialsuperintendens zu Lutzelstein, Doctor Johann Marbach … | 1558 | 14, p. 257 | 492 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ottheinrich |
| 24 | [Polizeimandat gegen das Unmaß bei Hochzeiten und Kindtaufen, auch bei Banketten, vom 14. Dezember 1558] | 1558 | 14, p. 261 | 493 | Agenda / liturgy | L | Friedrich III |
| 26 | Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc., aufgerichte christliche policeyordnung [vom 30. Juli 1562] | 1562 | 14, p. 264 | 493 | Discipline / police | R | Friedrich III |
| 27 | Pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten, aufgerichte christliche eheordnung [vom 30.Juli 1563] | 1563 | 14, p. 275 | 495 | Marriage | R | Friedrich III |
| 29 | [Ehegerichtsordnung von 1563] | 1563 | 14, p. 289 | 496 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 30 | [Mandat zur erneuten Einschärfung der Polizeiordnung vom 20. September 1563] | 1563 | 14, p. 332 | 497 | Discipline / police | R | Friedrich III |
| 31 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heiligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herren … | 1563 | 14, p. 333 | 498 | Church order | R | Friedrich III |
| 32 | [Kirchenratsordnung vom 21. Juli 1564] | 1564 | 14, p. 409 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 33 | [Kirchendienerbestallung vom 21. Juli 1564] | 1564 | 14, p. 425 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 35 | Ordnung des wochenlichen almusens zu Haidelberg [von etwa 1564] | 1564 | 14, p. 428 | 504 | Poor relief | R | Friedrich III |
| 36 | [Befehl an die Amtleute vom 3. Oktober 1565, in den Kirchen die Bilder, Altäre und sonstigen Kirchenzierrat abzuschaffen] | 1565 | 14, p. 429 | 504 | Mandate / decree | R | Friedrich III |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | [Bestallung eines Beisitzers des Kirchenrats und Aufsehers über die Druckerei vom 1. August 1566] | 1566 | 14, p. 430 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 41 | [Kirchendienerbestallung, zwischen 1566 und 1570] | 1570 | 14, p. 431 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 44 | [Edikt über die Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung, die Einrichtung der Kirchendisziplin und der Classicalconvente und die Verbesserung des Almosens vom … | 1570 | 14, p. 436 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 45 | [Befehl vom 9. August 1570, das Edikt vom 13. Juli 1570 über die Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung, die Einrichtung der Kirchendisziplin und der … | 1570 | 14, p. 441 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 46 | [Befehl vom 12. August 1570 gegen die Handhabung des Kirchenbanns durch die Kirchendiener und gegen Kanzelpolemik] | 1570 | 14, p. 442 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 47 | Almusenordnung der statt Haydelberg [um 1570] | 1570 | 14, p. 443 | 504 | Poor relief | R | Friedrich III |
| 48 | [Bericht des Kirchenratspräsidenten Wenzel Zuleger an Kurfürst Friedrich III. über die Einrichtung von Classicalconventen und Presbyterien vom … | 1571 | 14, p. 446 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 49 | Verkhündung der senioren [für Rheinpfalz und die Vordere Grafschaft Sponheim vom Frühjahr 1571[ | 1571 | 14, p. 447 | 504 | Other | R | Friedrich III |
| 50 | Officium presbyterorum [für Rheinpfalz und die Vordere Grafschaft Sponheim von 1571[ | 1571 | 14, p. 448 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 51 | [Bericht der Pfarrer und Theologen der Kirche und Universität zu Heidelberg über das kurpfälzische Kirchenwesen vom 25. April 1571] | 1571 | 14, p. 450 | 504 | School / university | R | Friedrich III |
| 52 | [Bestallung eines Glöckners vom 15. Mai 1572] | 1572 | 14, p. 455 | 504 | Appointment / oath | R | Friedrich III |
| 54 | Churf.[urstlicher] Pfaltz resolution uf die gemeine mengel, im synodo den 16. Maii a[nn]o etc. [15]73. zu Heidelberg fürgelaufen undt allen obern … | n.d. | 14, p. 458 | 504 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich III |
| 55 | Pfaltzqrave Friderichs, churfürstens etc. aufgerichte christliche almusenordnung [vom 17. Februar 1574] | 1574 | 14, p. 458 | 504 | Poor relief | R | Friedrich III |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 56 | Mandat und constitution, welcher gestalt die blutschanden, notzucht, raub oder entführung, auch ehebruch, hurerey und dergleichen laster zu strafen … | 1575 | 14, p. 484 | 504 | Mandate / decree | R | Friedrich III |
| 58 | Ordnung und befehlch, was unser pfaltzgrave Friderichs, churfürsten etc., verwalter und andere zugeordtnete personen über die kirchengüter und … | 1576 | 14, p. 489 | 504 | Property / endowment | R | Friedrich III |
| 66 | Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder minister, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz zu einem kirchendiener aufgenommen wirdt, anzugeloben und zu … | 1580 | 14, p. 506 | 505 | Consistory / synod / government | L | Ludwig VI |
| 67 | Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz aufgenommen wirdt, promission thun solle etc. [von 1580] | 1580 | 14, p. 508 | 505 | School / university | L | Ludwig VI |
| 80 | Pfaltzgraf Johann Casimirs etc., vormunds und der churfürstlichen Pfaltz administrators etc. mandat und befelch, daß bey etlichen kirchen und schuln … | 1584 | 14, p. 510 | 506 | School / university | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 83 | [Kirchenratsordnung vom 6. September 1585] | 1585 | 14, p. 515 | 507 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 84 | Verzeichnus etlicher bestallungspuncten, darauf ein jeder, so in churfürstlicher Pfaltz zum Kirchendienst aufgenommen wirdt, mit handtgegebner treu … | 1586 | 14, p. 524 | 508 | School / university | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 85 | Ordo, so in conventibus classicis hinfuro zu halten [vom Mai 1587] | 1587 | 14, p. 527 | 509 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 86 | [Bestallung eines Inspektors vom 2. Juni 1587] | 1587 | 14, p. 534 | 510 | Appointment / oath | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 87 | [Revers und Bestallung eines Kirchenrats vom 1. Januar 1588] | 1588 | 14, p. 541 | 511 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Johann Casimir as administrator |
| 91 | [Kirchenratsordnung, wohl von 1593] | 1593 | 14, p. 544 | 513 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich IV |
| 96 | Kirchenordnung, wie es mit der christlichen lehre, heyligen sacramenten und ceremonien in des durchleuchtigsten, hochgebornen fürsten und herrn … | 1601 | 14, p. 556 | 514 | Church order | R | Friedrich IV |
| 97 | Churfürstlicher Pfaltz kirchendienerbestallungspuncten [vom 4. Juli 1601] | 1601 | 14, p. 586 | 515 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich IV |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 98 | Churfürstlicher Pfaltz schuldienerbestallungspuncten [vom 4. Juli 1601] | 1601 | 14, p. 591 | 516 | School / university | R | Friedrich IV |
| 100 | Presbyteri- oder altistenordnung, wie es damit in churfurstlicher Pfaltz gehalten werden soll [wohl von 1601 ] | 1601 | 14, p. 593 | 517 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich IV |
| 103 | Ordnung gewisser zusammenkunften der kirchendiener (classici conventus genandt), wie es damit in churfürstlicher Pfaltz gehalten werden soll [vom 6. … | 1607 | 14, p. 604 | 519 | Consistory / synod / government | R | Friedrich IV |

## 1.23 Volume 15: Württemberg I: County of Hohenlohe

108 texts.

### 1.23.1 County of Hohenlohe

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bestallung des ersten evangelischen Predigers Caspar Huberinus am 25. April und 12. Mai 1544 (Ö) 1 | 1544 | 15, p. 23 | 532 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 2 | Liederliste der Öhringer Stiftskirche (ab 1544/1546) <Ö> | 1546 | 15, p. 28 | 534 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 3 | Vermahnungen und Gebete für den Gottesdienst in Öhringen 1544-1550 <Ö> | 1550 | 15, p. 31 | 535 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Eine ordnung, wie es in der schuell zue Öringen gehalten möchte werden. 6. Eebruar 1549 <Ö> | 1549 | 15, p. 45 | 537 | School / university | L | |
| 5 | Christliche kirchenordnung der graveschaft Hohennloe etc. 1553 | 1553 | 15, p. 53 | 538 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Polizeiordnung vom 27. Januar 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 82 | 540 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 7 | Bestallung und Revers von Pfarrern 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 88 | 541 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7a | Bestallung des Prädikanten David Püttner vom 5. März 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 89 | 542 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7b | Revers von Veit Kestner in Münster von 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 90 | 542 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 8 | Durchführung der Reformation 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 93 | 543 | Other | L | |
| 8a | Befehl, zur Bekanntgabe der Reformation zu erscheinen, vom 21. Mai 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 95 | 543 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8b | Eragstück, daruf die pfarherren und geforderte personen in der examination und inquisition sollen gefragt werden. 9. Juni 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 95 | 543 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Reformation und Ordnung des Öhringer Stifts 1556 <Ö> | 1556 | 15, p. 97 | 544 | Church order | L | |
| 9a | Bericht über die Beratung in Öhringen im Februar 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 99 | 545 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9b | Waldenburger Bedenken vom 10. September 1556 | 1556 | 15, p. 101 | 545 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9c | Verzeichnus, wie es in den stiftskirchen mit singen und lesen soll gehalten werden etc | n.d. | 15, p. 103 | 545 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 10 | Stipendiatenreverse ab 1556 <Ö, H> | 1556 | 15, p. 105 | 546 | School / university | L | |
| 11 | Pfarrpräsentationsordnung | n.d. | 15, p. 111 | 548 | Other | L | |
| 11a | Ordrrang, wie die neuen pfarrherrn der ldrchen fürgestelt nnd ihnen anß befelch nnßerer gnädigen herrschaft das pfarrampt befohlen soll werden | n.d. | 15, p. 112 | 548 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11h | Präsentationsbefehl vom 14. März 1572 <N) | 1572 | 15, p. 114 | 548 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12 | Visitation 1558 | 1558 | 15, p. 116 | 549 | Visitation | L | |
| 12a | Visitations- nnd Kirchenordnnng von 1558 <H, Wa> | 1558 | 15, p. 120 | 549 | Visitation | L | |
| 12b | Waldenbnrger Generalartikel nach der Visitation | n.d. | 15, p. 132 | 549 | Visitation | L | |
| 13 | Polizeiordnung vom 26. September 1558 | 1558 | 15, p. 134 | 550 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 14 | Befehl wegen Besuch von Gottesdiensten, Beerdigungen und Almosen (um 1558) | 1558 | 15, p. 146 | 551 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15 | Befehl wegen der Bettler nnd des Almosens vom 10. Januar 1562 | 1562 | 15, p. 148 | 552 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 16 | Testament Graf Lndwig Casimirs vom 29. Juli 1564 | 1564 | 15, p. 150 | 554 | Other | L | |
| 17 | Polizeiordnung vom 19. Februar 1571 | 1571 | 15, p. 155 | 555 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 18 | Visitation 1571 | 1571 | 15, p. 159 | 556 | Visitation | L | |
| 18a | Visitation 1571 : Visitationsinstruktion vom 20. Mai 1571 | 1571 | 15, p. 161 | 556 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18b | Visitation 1571 : Visitationspatent vom 20. Mai 1571 | 1571 | 15, p. 166 | 556 | Visitation | L | |
| 18c | Ordnung, welche allen pfarherrn ubergeben worden | n.d. | 15, p. 167 | 556 | Local order | L | |
| 18d | Der herschaft bevelch an die pfarrher, haltung der freytagspredig | n.d. | 15, p. 169 | 556 | Other | L | |
| 19 | Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572 | 1572 | 15, p. 171 | 557 | Marriage | L | |
| 19a | Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572 : Eheordnung (Langfassung) | 1572 | 15, p. 174 | 559 | Marriage | L | |
| 19b | Eheordnung vom 6. November 1572 : Summarische Eheordnung (Kurzfassung) | 1572 | 15, p. 200 | 559 | Marriage | L | |
| 20 | Kanzleiordnung vom 16. August 1574 | 1574 | 15, p. 207 | 560 | Other | L | |
| 21 | Registratorenordnung vom 22. Februar 1575 (mit Änderungen) | 1575 | 15, p. 214 | 563 | Other | L | |
| 22 | Reverse der Pfarrer von Hollenbach und Adolzhausen an den Deutschen Orden seit dem Januar 1578 | 1578 | 15, p. 221 | 566 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 23 | Kirchenordnung, die im Amt Schillingsfürst bis 1578 gehalten wurde | 1578 | 15, p. 226 | 567 | Church order | L | |
| 24 | Verbot cles Weinschenkens für die Öhringer Kirchendiener vom 3. Juni 1578 <Ö> | 1578 | 15, p. 228 | 568 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 25 | Kirchenordnung 1578 | 1578 | 15, p. 230 | 569 | Church order | L | |
| 25a | Kirchenordnung 1578 | 1578 | 15, p. 254 | 574 | Church order | L | |
| 25b | Befehl an clie Amtsdiener bei Einführung der Kirchenordnung vom 6. Oktober 1578 <Ö, N> | 1578 | 15, p. 352 | 574 | Church order | L | |
| 25c | Befehl für Öhringen wegen des Katechismus und der Bibliothek vom 24. August 1579 <Ö> | 1579 | 15, p. 353 | 574 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 26 | Kapitels- und Visitationsorclnung vom 12. April 1579 | 1579 | 15, p. 354 | 575 | Visitation | L | |
| 27 | Konsistorialordnung vom 21. Mai 1579 | 1579 | 15, p. 383 | 579 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 28 | Verbot der öffentlichen Kirchenzucht vom 1. Eebruar 1580 | 1580 | 15, p. 407 | 583 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 29 | Visitation 1581 | 1581 | 15, p. 410 | 584 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 29a | Visitationsinstruktion vom 2./5. Januar 1581 | 1581 | 15, p. 414 | 584 | Visitation | L | |
| 29b | Visitation 1581 : Visitationspatent | 1581 | 15, p. 419 | 584 | Visitation | L | |
| 29c | Befehl an clie Spezialsuperintendenten, wie sie ihre eigenen Pfarreien visitieren sollen, vom 9. Februar 1581 | 1581 | 15, p. 420 | 584 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 29d | Wie es der außlendischen pfarren halben mit der visitation gehalten werden soll | n.d. | 15, p. 421 | 584 | Visitation | L | |
| 30 | Befehl bei Übersendung des Konkordienbuches vom 19. März 1581 <Ö> | 1581 | 15, p. 424 | 585 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 31 | Befehl nach der Visitation für Öhringen (nach dem 5. November 1581) <Ö> | 1581 | 15, p. 426 | 586 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 32 | Kirchen- uncl Schulordnungen 1582 | 1582 | 15, p. 433 | 587 | School / university | L | |
| 33 | Polizei- und Eheordnung vom 16. Januar 1583 | 1583 | 15, p. 509 | 593 | Marriage | L | |
| 34 | Befehl wegen Länge cler Predigten vom 25. Juli 1585 | 1585 | 15, p. 519 | 597 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 35 | Verbot der Kirchweihen, des Spielens und Tanzens vom 13. Mai 1586 | 1586 | 15, p. 521 | 598 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 36 | Amtsordming vom 22. Februar 1587 | 1587 | 15, p. 523 | 599 | Other | L | |
| 37 | Fragen über die Kirchenzeremonien vom Juni 1587 | 1587 | 15, p. 531 | 601 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 38 | Neuensteiner Befehle in Kriegsgefahr, besonders wegen des täglichen Gebetsgottesdienstes vom 1. Februar 1588 bis 14. August 1594 | 1594 | 15, p. 536 | 603 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 38a | Befehl an die Kirchendiener wegen eines Gebets in den Gottesdiensten uncl cles täglichen Gebets vom 1. Februar 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 538 | 604 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 38b | Christlich gebett zur zeit cler kriegsleuf und feindesnot | n.d. | 15, p. 540 | 604 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 38c | Befehl an die Amtsdiener wegen der Freitagspredigten, des täglichen Gebets uncl der Abschaffung von Fressen und Saufen vom 1. Februar 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 541 | 604 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 38d | Befehl an die Amtsdiener, besonders gegen Fressen uncl von Saufen von 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 542 | 604 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 38e | Befehl an die Kirchendiener wegen Läutens der Türkenglocken und cles täglichen Gebets vom 18. August 1594 | 1594 | 15, p. 544 | 604 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 38f | Befehl an die Amtscliener wegen Läutens der Tiirkenglocken, des täglichen Gebets und cler Abschaffung von Fressen und Saufen vom 21. August 1594 | 1594 | 15, p. 546 | 604 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 39 | Weikersheimer Befehle wegen der Eheverkündigung, der Beichtpfennige und cles täglichen Gebetsgottesdienstes vom 23. April 1588 bis 18. Mai 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 548 | 605 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 39a | Befehl an den Weikersheimer Superintendenten wegen der Eheverkündigung und der Beichtpfennige vom 23. April 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 549 | 605 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 39b | Befehl an die Pfarrer wegen des täglichen Gebets, der Eheverkündigung und cler Beichtpfennige vom 24. April 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 549 | 605 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 39c | Instruction, wie das alltäglich gebet, so in diser herrschaft angerichtet werden soll, den gemeinen furzuhalten uncl zu commenclieren | n.d. | 15, p. 550 | 605 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| | cl) Gebet in Feindes- und anderen Nöten | n.d. | 15, p. 552 | 605 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 39e | Befehl an clen Ingelfinger Keller wegen des täglichen Gebets vom 1. Mai 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 553 | 605 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 39f | Befehl an den Ingelfinger Superintendenten wegen des täglichen Gebets vom 18. Mai 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 553 | 605 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 40 | Langenburger Gebet in Kriegszeiten von 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 554 | 606 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 41 | Gemeinsame Beschlüsse der Neuensteiner Linie vom 22. Juni 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 555 | 607 | Other | L | |
| 42 | Eicle, Reserve und Bestallungen der Kirchendiener ab 1588 | 1588 | 15, p. 559 | 608 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 42a | Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener von 1588 <0, N> | 1588 | 15, p. 562 | 608 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 42b | Revers und Bestallung für clie Herrschaft Weikersheim von 1590 | 1590 | 15, p. 563 | 608 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 42c | Reverse und Bestallungen für Öhringen uncl clie Herrschaft Weikersheim ab 1595 <Ö, Wk> | 1595 | 15, p. 567 | 608 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 42d | Bestimmung über Bestallungen und Reverse aus der Waldenburger Hofordnung vom Mai 1594 | 1594 | 15, p. 570 | 609 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 43 | Polizei- und Rügordnung vom 25. September 1588 <Wk, N> | 1588 | 15, p. 571 | 610 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 44 | Einführung der Gesangsordnung vom 2. Februar 1589 | 1589 | 15, p. 596 | 614 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 44a | Befehl bei Einführung der Gesangsordnung vom 2. Februar 1589 | 1589 | 15, p. 596 | 614 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 44b | Befehl wegen des Gesangs beim Katechismusgottesclienst vom. 17. Februar 1589 | 1589 | 15, p. 597 | 614 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 45 | Visitationsordnung vom 26. März 1589 <Wk, Ö> | 1589 | 15, p. 598 | 615 | Visitation | L | |
| 46 | Befehl wegen des Almosens vom 4. September 1589 | 1589 | 15, p. 616 | 620 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 47 | Befehl zum Besuch des Katechismusunterrichts in cler Passionszeit vom 7. März 1590 | 1590 | 15, p. 619 | 621 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 48 | Befehle wegen der Chorröcke und Tüchlein beim Abendmahl von 1590 uncl 1595 | 1595 | 15, p. 621 | 622 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 48a | Befehl an die Pfarrer wegen der Chorröcke und Tüchlein beim Abendmahl vom 30. November 1590 | 1590 | 15, p. 621 | 622 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 48b | Bcfehl an den Keller von Ingelfingen wegen cler Chorröcke nnd der Tüchlein beim Abenclmahl vom 2. Jnli 1595 | 1595 | 15, p. 622 | 622 | Other | L | |
| 49 | Eheverkündignng, wenn sich jemancl in katholische Orte verheiratet (vor dem 1. Jnni 1592) | 1592 | 15, p. 623 | 623 | Marriage | L | |
| 50 | Befehle znr Einführung kirchlicher Ordnnngen im Amt Langenbnrg vom 1. Juni 1592 | 1592 | 15, p. 624 | 624 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 50a | Befehl zur Einführung kirchlicher Orclnungen an clen Pfarrer von Langenbnrg vom Juni 1592 | 1592 | 15, p. 625 | 624 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 1b | Befehl znr Einführung kirchlicher Ordnungen an clie Eorfpfarrer im Amt Langenburg vom 1. Jnni 1592 | 1592 | 15, p. 626 | 624 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 51 | Verbot des Verschleierns der Erauen beim Abendmahl vom 11. August 1592 | 1592 | 15, p. 627 | 625 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 52 | Öhringer Spitalordnung vom 2. Januar 1594 <Ö> | 1594 | 15, p. 629 | 626 | Poor relief | L | |
| 53 | Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs, der Precligtlänge und der Schulvisitation vom 23. November 1594 | 1594 | 15, p. 639 | 627 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 54 | Schul- und Gesangsordnung samt Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien vom 22. Eezember 1596 | 1596 | 15, p. 641 | 628 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 54a | Unser Wolffgangs, ... schuel- und gesangsordnung ... <Wk, IST > | n.d. | 15, p. 649 | 628 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 54b | Übersendung der Ordnung an die Superintendenten am 26. Eezember 1596 | 1596 | 15, p. 664 | 629 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 54c | Schreiben wegen Eurchführung der Ordnung vom 24. Januar 1597 | 1597 | 15, p. 665 | 630 | Other | L | |
| 55 | Kirchenzucht wegen vorehelicher Beziehungen vom 3. Eezember 1601 | 1601 | 15, p. 666 | 631 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 56 | Erb- und Teilungsverträge 1609-1615 | 1615 | 15, p. 668 | 632 | Other | L | |
| 56a | Erb- und Teilungsverträge 1609-1615: Neue Erbeinigung vom 26. Juni 1609 | 1609 | 15, p. 671 | 633 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 56b | Neuensteiner Informationslibell vom 31. Januar 1610 | 1610 | 15, p. 673 | 633 | Other | L | |
| 56c | Waldenburger Regimentsordnungsrezeß vom 3. Eezember 1615 | 1615 | 15, p. 677 | 633 | Other | L | |

## 1.24 Volume 16: Baden-Württemberg II: Württemberg, Baden, Limpurg

108 texts.

### 1.24.1 Duchy of Württemberg (with Mömpelgard and Horburg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The Interim was imposed 1548-1552.
- **Interim**: 5 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mandat zur Anstellung evangelischer Geistlicher 1534 | 1534 | 16, p. 74 | 645 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Mandat zur Anstellung evangelischer Prediger in den Klöstern 1535 | 1535 | 16, p. 75 | 646 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Klosterordnung [1535] | 1535 | 16, p. 76 | 647 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 4 | Reversformulare für austretende Konventualen [um 1535] | 1535 | 16, p. 81 | 647 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Entwurf einer Eheordnung 1535 | 1535 | 16, p. 83 | 648 | Marriage | L | |
| 6 | Eheordnung [1536] | 1536 | 16, p. 92 | 649 | Marriage | L | |
| 7 | Kastenordnung 1536 | 1536 | 16, p. 95 | 650 | Poor relief | L | |
| 8 | Kirchenordnung 1536 | 1536 | 16, p. 103 | 651 | Church order | L | |
| 9 | Vorrede und Artikel zur Kirchenordnung 1536 | 1536 | 16, p. 129 | 652 | Church order | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Visitationsordnung [1535] | 1535 | 16, p. 136 | 653 | Visitation | L | |
| 11 | Visitationsinstruktion [1536] | 1536 | 16, p. 140 | 654 | Visitation | L | |
| 12 | Mandat zum Pfarrerexamen 1538 | 1538 | 16, p. 143 | 655 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 13 | Bildermandat 1540 | 1540 | 16, p. 144 | 656 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14 | Mandat zur Entfernung von Altären und Anschaffung deutscher Bibeln 1540 | 1540 | 16, p. 145 | 657 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15 | Ordnung des Zisterzienserklosters Mariäkron in Rechentshofen 1539 | 1539 | 16, p. 146 | 658 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 16 | Visitationsordnung 1547 | 1547 | 16, p. 149 | 659 | Visitation | L | |
| 17 | Synodalordnung 1547 | 1547 | 16, p. 157 | 660 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 18 | Interimsmandat 1548 | 1548 | 16, p. 166 | 661 | Mandate / decree | L | **Interim order** |
| 19 | Mandat zur Wiederanstellung evangelischer Prediger 1549 | 1549 | 16, p. 168 | 662 | Mandate / decree | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 20 | Kirchenratsmandat 1548 | 1548 | 16, p. 169 | 663 | Consistory / synod / government | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 21 | Zuchtordnung für Horburg und Reichenweier 1546 | 1546 | 16, p. 171 | 664 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 22 | Kirchenordnung für Mömpelgard [1537/38] | 1537 | 16, p. 175 | 665 | Church order | L | |
| 23a | Ordnung der Prädikantenanstellung in Mömpelgard 1545 | 1545 | 16, p. 188 | 665 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 23b | Eid der Prädikanten in Mömpelgard 1545 | 1545 | 16, p. 189 | 665 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 23c | Examensartikel für die Mömpelgarder und Blamonter Kirchendiener 1546 | 1546 | 16, p. 190 | 665 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 23d | Examensartikel für die Mömpelgarder Kirchendiener 1552 | 1552 | 16, p. 192 | 665 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 24 | Artikel für den Mömpelgarder Klerus 1545 | 1545 | 16, p. 194 | 666 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 25 | Predigtmandat 1550 | 1550 | 16, p. 197 | 667 | Mandate / decree | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 26 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe 1552 | 1552 | 16, p. 198 | 668 | Mandate / decree | L | **End of the Interim** |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 27 | Mandat gegen Aufnahme von Novizen in den Klöstern 1552 | 1552 | 16, p. 199 | 669 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 28 | Kastenordnung 1552 | 1552 | 16, p. 200 | 670 | Poor relief | L | |
| 29 | Kirchenordnung 1553 | 1553 | 16, p. 223 | 671 | Church order | L | |
| 30 | Eheordnung 1553 | 1553 | 16, p. 277 | 672 | Marriage | L | |
| 31 | Instruktion zur Kirchendienerbesoldung [um 1553] | 1553 | 16, p. 284 | 673 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 32 | Mandat zur Kirchendienerbesoldung und Besetzung vakanter Stellen 1554 | 1554 | 16, p. 286 | 674 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 33 | Visitationsordnung 1553 | 1553 | 16, p. 287 | 675 | Visitation | L | |
| 34 | Mandat zur Abschaffung von Feld- und zum Erhalt von Predigtkirchen 1555 | 1555 | 16, p. 292 | 676 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 35 | Mandat zur Abschaffung von Monstranzen, Weihwassersteinen, Bildern 1555 | 1555 | 16, p. 293 | 677 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 36a | Klosterordnung 1556: Protokoll der Prälatenversammlung | 1556 | 16, p. 294 | 677 | Other | L | |
| 36b | Klosterordnung 1556: Ordnung für Männerklöster | 1556 | 16, p. 296 | 677 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 36c | Klosterordnung 1556: Ordnung für Frauenklöster | 1556 | 16, p. 304 | 677 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 37 | Statuten für das Zisterzienserkloster Herrenalb 1556 | 1556 | 16, p. 317 | 678 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 38 | Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten [nach 1556] | 1556 | 16, p. 321 | 679 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 39 | Visitationsartikel [um 1556/57] | 1556 | 16, p. 324 | 680 | Visitation | L | |
| 40 | Mandat zur Entfernung von Sakramentshäuschen 1556 | 1556 | 16, p. 325 | 681 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 41 | Visitationsordnung 1557 | 1557 | 16, p. 326 | 682 | Visitation | L | |
| 42 | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede | 1559 | 16, p. 344 | 683 | Church order | L | |
| 42a | Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen | n.d. | 16, p. 347 | 683 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 42b | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der Klosterschulen | 1559 | 16, p. 361 | 683 | School / university | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 42c | Ordnung gegen die Täufer und andere abweichende Lehren | n.d. | 16, p. 381 | 683 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 42d | Visitationsordnung für die Superintendenten | n.d. | 16, p. 385 | 683 | Visitation | L | |
| 42e | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der politischen Visitation | 1559 | 16, p. 395 | 683 | Visitation | L | |
| 42f | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Landinspektion | 1559 | 16, p. 399 | 683 | Other | L | |
| 42g | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung der Kirchenzensur | 1559 | 16, p. 404 | 683 | Church order | L | |
| 42h | Ordnung des Konvents der Superintendenten | n.d. | 16, p. 408 | 683 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 42i | Unterhaltsordnung für Kirchendiener, Schulen und Pädagogium | n.d. | 16, p. 410 | 683 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 42k | Große Kirchenordnung 1559, Vorrede: Ordnung des Kirchenrats | 1559 | 16, p. 413 | 683 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 43 | Bekenntnis der württembergischen Theologen zum Abendmahl 1560 | 1560 | 16, p. 420 | 684 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 44 | Eid der Kirchendiener [nach 1559] | 1559 | 16, p. 424 | 685 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 45 | Hofkirchenordnung 1560 | 1560 | 16, p. 426 | 686 | Church order | L | |
| 46 | Instruktion für die Superintendenten 1561 | 1561 | 16, p. 429 | 687 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 47 | Mandat zu Feiertagen und Taufzeremonie [um 1560] | 1560 | 16, p. 435 | 688 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 48 | Abendmahlsmandat 1562 | 1562 | 16, p. 436 | 689 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 49 | Instruktion für die evangelischen Prälaten [1563] | 1563 | 16, p. 437 | 690 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 50 | Büchermandat 1564 | 1564 | 16, p. 442 | 691 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 51 | Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel 1577 | 1577 | 16, p. 444 | 692 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 52 | Kirchenratsordnung 1569/1578 | 1578 | 16, p. 446 | 693 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 53 | Große Kirchenordnung 1582, Vorrede | 1582 | 16, p. 460 | 694 | Church order | L | |
| 54 | Ehegerichtsordnung 1586 | 1586 | 16, p. 462 | 695 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 55 | Büchermandat 1593 | 1593 | 16, p. 468 | 696 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 56 | Visitationsinstruktion für die Spezialsuperintendenten 1597 | 1597 | 16, p. 470 | 697 | Visitation | L | |
| 57 | Verbot der Eheschließung von Protestanten mit Katholiken 1609 | 1609 | 16, p. 472 | 698 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 58 | Mandat zur Kastenordnung 1614 | 1614 | 16, p. 473 | 699 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.24.2 Margraviate of Baden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1533 | 1533 | 16, p. 499 | 702 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Klostermandat 1528 | 1528 | 16, p. 512 | 703 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 3 | Wiedertäufermandat 1543 | 1543 | 16, p. 513 | 704 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenzuchtmandat 1548 | 1548 | 16, p. 517 | 705 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung 1556 | 1556 | 16, p. 519 | 706 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Visitationsordnung 1556 | 1556 | 16, p. 522 | 707 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Kollaturvertrag 1561 | 1561 | 16, p. 528 | 708 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 8 | Pfarrhausmandat 1564 | 1564 | 16, p. 532 | 709 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1564 | 1564 | 16, p. 533 | 710 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Kirchenordnungsmandat Lahr 1567 | 1567 | 16, p. 539 | 711 | Church order | L | |
| 11 | Eheordnung 1581 | 1581 | 16, p. 540 | 712 | Marriage | L | |
| 12 | Kirchenordnungsmandat 1601 | 1601 | 16, p. 551 | 713 | Church order | L | |
| 13 | Dienstleutemandat 1602 | 1602 | 16, p. 556 | 714 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Kirchenordnungsmandate 1603 | 1603 | 16, p. 557 | 715 | Church order | L | |
| 15 | Ehebruchmandat 1604 | 1604 | 16, p. 563 | 716 | Marriage | L | |
| 16 | Toleranzmandat 1608 | 1608 | 16, p. 570 | 717 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 17 | Sonntagsmandat 1609 | 1609 | 16, p. 571 | 718 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 18 | Fastnachtsmandat 1610 | 1610 | 16, p. 572 | 719 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 19 | Predigtmandat 1610 | 1610 | 16, p. 573 | 720 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 20 | Jesuitenmandat 1611 | 1611 | 16, p. 574 | 721 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 21 | Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617 | 1617 | 16, p. 576 | 722 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.24.3 County of Limpurg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Pfarrstellenbesetzungsrevers 1537 | 1537 | 16, p. 589 | 725 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 2 | Eheordnung 1573 | 1573 | 16, p. 591 | 726 | Marriage | L | |
| 2b | Eheordnung 1573: Extrakt der Eheordnung 1610 | 1610 | 16, p. 603 | 726 | Marriage | L | |
| 3 | Ordinationsordnung 1590 | 1590 | 16, p. 607 | 727 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenbußmandat 1596 | 1596 | 16, p. 609 | 728 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung 1610 | 1610 | 16, p. 610 | 729 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Visitationsordnung 1611 | 1611 | 16, p. 625 | 730 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Ehebruchmandat 1614 | 1614 | 16, p. 632 | 731 | Marriage | L | |
| 8 | Kirchenbußordnung 1620 | 1620 | 16, p. 634 | 732 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.24.4 Lordship of Kinzigtal (Fürstenberg)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Sieben Artikel 1542 | 1542 | 16, p. 644 | 735 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Kompetenzmandat 1542 | 1542 | 16, p. 646 | 736 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Landesordnung 1543 (Auszug) | 1543 | 16, p. 647 | 737 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4 | Visitationsmandat 1546 | 1546 | 16, p. 650 | 738 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.24.5 Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Kirchenordnung 1560 | 1560 | 16, p. 657 | 741 | Church order | L | |

### 1.25 Volume 17/1: Baden-Württemberg III/1: Hall, Heilbronn, Konstanz, Isny, Gengenbach

78 texts.

#### 1.25.1 Imperial city of Schwäbisch Hall

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Hall kept the Interim order until 1559.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Frühmessordnung 1526 | 1526 | 17/1, p. 37 | 754 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung 1527 | 1527 | 17/1, p. 42 | 755 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen sowie bei Eheeinsegnungen [1527] | 1527 | 17/1, p. 66 | 756 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4a | Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Ordnung gegen Gotteslästerung, Trunksucht und Kuppelei | 1527 | 17/1, p. 71 | 756 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4b | Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Einfiihrungspredigt zur Ordnung gegen Gotteslästerung u.a | 1527 | 17/1, p. 74 | 756 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4c | Sitten- und Kirchenzuchtmandate [1527]: Einführungspredigt zum Feiertagsmandat | 1527 | 17/1, p. 77 | 756 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Katechismus für Schwäbisch Hall [1528] | 1528 | 17/1, p. 81 | 757 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 6 | Katechismus für Schwäbisch Hall 1535 | 1535 | 17/1, p. 93 | 758 | Catechism / instruction | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Sendordnung 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 96 | 759 | Other | L | |
| 8 | Entwurf einer Gottesdienstordnung für die Haller Landgemeinde Bibersfeld 1535 | 1535 | 17/1, p. 101 | 760 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9 | Agende für das Krankenabendmahl 1537 | 1537 | 17/1, p. 103 | 761 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 10 | Kirchenordnung 1543/1615 | 1615 | 17/1, p. 111 | 762 | Church order | L | |
| 11 | Ordnung der Feiertage 1545 | 1545 | 17/1, p. 192 | 763 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12a | Täufermandate: Verbot, sich den Täufern anzuschließen 1545 | 1545 | 17/1, p. 193 | 763 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12b | Täufermandate: Verbot, mit den Täufern Handel zu treiben 1548 | 1548 | 17/1, p. 195 | 763 | Mandate / decree | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 12c | Täufermandate: Einzug der Täufergüter durch den Rat 1576 | 1576 | 17/1, p. 196 | 763 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 13 | Statuten des Landkapitels [1553] | 1553 | 17/1, p. 197 | 763 | Consistory / synod / government | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 14 | Eheordnung 1559 | 1559 | 17/1, p. 201 | 763 | Marriage | L | |
| 15 | Auszug aus der Eheordnung 1570/1599 | 1599 | 17/1, p. 205 | 763 | Marriage | L | |
| 16 | Anleitung zum Beichtunterricht 1574 | 1574 | 17/1, p. 209 | 763 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 17 | Ordnung gegen Trunksucht, Fluchen, Schwören, Ehebruch und Hurerei 1599 | 1599 | 17/1, p. 213 | 763 | Marriage | L | |

#### 1.25.2 Imperial city of Heilbronn

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ratsbeschluss zur Zulassung des evangelischen Abendmahls 1528 | 1528 | 17/1, p. 236 | 766 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Mandat zu Abendmahl und Katechismusunterricht 1528 | 1528 | 17/1, p. 237 | 767 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Heilbronner Katechismus 1528 | 1528 | 17/1, p. 238 | 768 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 4 | Entwurf einer Ordnung der Sittenzucht und der Feiertage [1529/30] | 1529 | 17/1, p. 269 | 769 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | „Confessio Heilbronnensis“ und Kirchenordnung 1530 | 1530 | 17/1, p. 273 | 770 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 6 | Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben 1530 | 1530 | 17/1, p. 290 | 771 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7 | Ratsprotokoll zur Abschaffung der Messe 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 292 | 772 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8 | Instruktion zur Abstimmung der Gemeinde über die Messfeier 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 293 | 773 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Messe unter den Präsenzherren 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 295 | 774 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 10 | Instruktion zur Abschaffung der Messe im Klarissenkloster 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 297 | 775 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 11 | Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 298 | 776 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12 | Verbot von Eheprozessen vor geistlichen Gerichten 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 299 | 777 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 13 | Entwurf einer Gottesdienstordnung 1532 | 1532 | 17/1, p. 300 | 778 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 14 | Gottesdienstordnung 1532 | 1532 | 17/1, p. 304 | 779 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 15 | Statuten zum Eherecht 1541 | 1541 | 17/1, p. 307 | 780 | Marriage | L | |
| 16 | Kirchenordnung 1543 | 1543 | 17/1, p. 313 | 781 | Church order | L | |
| 17 | Ordnung des Kirchengesangs [1543] | 1543 | 17/1, p. 320 | 782 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 18 | Kirchenordnung 1603 | 1603 | 17/1, p. 327 | 783 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.25.3 Imperial city of Konstanz

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwick, Blarer); the Reformation ended when Konstanz fell to Austria in 1548.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reformationsratschlag für den Städtetag in Ulm 1524 | 1524 | 17/1, p. 347 | 786 | Other | MR | |
| 2a | Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Predigtmandat 1524 | 1524 | 17/1, p. 362 | 786 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 2b | Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Edikt gegen Ehebruch und Hurerei 1527 | 1527 | 17/1, p. 363 | 786 | Mandate / decree | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2c | Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Eheeinsegnungen [1528] | 1528 | 17/1, p. 364 | 786 | Marriage | MR | |
| 2d | Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Taufen [um 1529] | 1529 | 17/1, p. 366 | 786 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 2e | Konstanzer Reformationsordnung 1524-1529: Ordnung der Feiertage 1527 | 1527 | 17/1, p. 368 | 786 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 3 | Ausschreiben gegen Fluchen, Gotteslästerung und Zutrinken [1526] | 1526 | 17/1, p. 370 | 787 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 4 | Almosenordnung 1527 | 1527 | 17/1, p. 372 | 788 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 5 | Almosenordnung 1532 | 1532 | 17/1, p. 378 | 789 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 6 | Almosenordnung 1545 | 1545 | 17/1, p. 381 | 790 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 7 | Mandat zur Eheschließung Minderjähriger, vor 5. April 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 383 | 790 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 8 | Zuchtordnung 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 384 | 790 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 9 | Mandat zur Feiertagsheiligung 1531 | 1531 | 17/1, p. 410 | 790 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 10 | Abschaffung der Klöpfleinsnächte 1535 | 1535 | 17/1, p. 411 | 790 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 11 | Abschaffung des Neujahrsansingens 1544 | 1544 | 17/1, p. 412 | 790 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 12 | Verbot, Hunde während des Gottesdienstes in der Kirche herumlaufen zu lassen 1537 | 1537 | 17/1, p. 413 | 790 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 13 | Strafen gegen Hunde, die während des Gottesdienstes in der Kirche herumlaufen 1543 | 1543 | 17/1, p. 414 | 790 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 14 | Ordnung der Eheaufgebote und Eheeinsegnungen 1537/1543/1548 | 1548 | 17/1, p. 415 | 791 | Marriage | MR | |
| 15 | Ordnung der Kirchenpflege [1538] | 1538 | 17/1, p. 416 | 792 | Church order | MR | |

#### 1.25.4 Imperial city of Isny

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Fagius) before the Interim; Lutheran after.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Moderate Reformed 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Zuchtherrenordnung [1533] | 1533 | 17/1, p. 429 | 796 | Discipline / police | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Auszug aus der Stadtordnung zum Eherecht 1544 | 1544 | 17/1, p. 435 | 797 | Marriage | MR | |
| 3 | Ehegerichtsordnung 1566/1600 | 1600 | 17/1, p. 439 | 798 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 4 | Ordnung des Ehegerichts [1600] | 1600 | 17/1, p. 451 | 799 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Agende [um 1600] | 1600 | 17/1, p. 455 | 800 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.25.5 Imperial city of Gengenbach

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: A short Reformation (1525-1548) under Strasbourg influence.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mandat zur Schulmeisteranstellung [1536-1544] | 1544 | 17/1, p. 483 | 804 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 2 | Schulmeisterordnung [1536-1544] | 1544 | 17/1, p. 484 | 805 | School / university | MR | |
| 3a | Schreiben der Prädikanten an den Rat, eine Kirchenordnung zu erlassen 1538 | 1538 | 17/1, p. 485 | 805 | Church order | MR | |
| 3b | Kirchenordnung 1538: Reformationsartikel der evangelischen Geistlichen 1538 | 1538 | 17/1, p. 488 | 805 | Other | MR | |
| 3c | Kirchenordnung 1538: Kirchenordnung [1538] | 1538 | 17/1, p. 491 | 805 | Church order | MR | |
| 4 | Vertrag zum Unterhalt des Pfarrers, seines Helfers und des Schulmeisters 1540 | 1540 | 17/1, p. 499 | 806 | School / university | MR | |
| 5 | Gengenbacher Katechismus 1545 | 1545 | 17/1, p. 501 | 807 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 6 | Ordnung zu Eherechtsfragen [1536-1544] | 1544 | 17/1, p. 512 | 808 | Marriage | MR | |

#### 1.25.6 Württemberg: school orders of the Great Church Order of 1559 (supplement to vol. 16)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 42l | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der Lateinschulen | 1559 | 17/1, p. 525 | 812 | School / university | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 42m | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung des Stuttgarter Pädagogiums | 1559 | 17/1, p. 553 | 813 | School / university | L | |
| 42n | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums | 1559 | 17/1, p. 555 | 813 | School / university | L | |
| 42o | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung für adelige Schüler und Studenten | 1559 | 17/1, p. 580 | 813 | Local order | L | |
| 42p | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der deutschen Schulen | 1559 | 17/1, p. 583 | 813 | School / university | L | |
| 42q | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung für Leib- und Wundärzte | 1559 | 17/1, p. 588 | 813 | Local order | L | |
| 42r | Die Schulordnungen aus der württembergischen Großen Kirchenordnung von 1559: Ordnung der Schreib- und Rechenschulen | 1559 | 17/1, p. 591 | 813 | School / university | L | |

## 1.26 Volume 17/2: Baden-Württemberg III/2: Reutlingen, Ulm, Esslingen and other cities

116 texts.

### 1.26.1 Imperial city of Reutlingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Täufermandat 1528 | 1528 | 17/2, p. 36 | 826 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung [um 1531] | 1531 | 17/2, p. 38 | 827 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs 1565/66 | 1565 | 17/2, p. 47 | 828 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4 | Zuchtordnung 1573 | 1573 | 17/2, p. 52 | 829 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Artikel der Schulvisitation 1574 | 1574 | 17/2, p. 57 | 830 | Visitation | L | |

### 1.26.2 Imperial city of Ulm

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Bucer, Oecolampadius, Blarer: order of 1531) until the Interim; Lutheran after, on the Württemberg model.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 20, Moderate Reformed 15.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Almosenordnung 1528 | 1528 | 17/2, p. 86 | 833 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 2 | Ulmer Katechismus des Konrad Sam 1528/1536 | 1536 | 17/2, p. 97 | 834 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 3 | Täufermandat 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 121 | 835 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 4 | Ratsbeschlüsse zu Taufen und Eheeinsegnungen 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 123 | 836 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 124 | 837 | Church order | MR | |
| 6 | Das „Handbüchlein“ - Die Ulmer Agende 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 163 | 838 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 7 | Ehegerichtsordnung 1534 | 1534 | 17/2, p. 184 | 839 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 8 | Mandat zum Verbot des Messbesuchs außerhalb von Ulm 1537 | 1537 | 17/2, p. 191 | 840 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 9a | Visitationsartikel o.D | n.d. | 17/2, p. 192 | 840 | Visitation | MR | early 1530s (editor), after the church order of 1531 |
| 9b | Visitationsartikel 1534 | 1534 | 17/2, p. 195 | 840 | Visitation | MR | |
| 9c | Visitationsartikel 1537 | 1537 | 17/2, p. 197 | 840 | Visitation | MR | |
| 10 | Ordnung für die Superintendenten des Ulmer Landgebiets [1537?] | 1537 | 17/2, p. 199 | 841 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 11 | Fragenkatalog für die Synode 1539 | 1539 | 17/2, p. 200 | 842 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 12 | Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung 1541 | 1541 | 17/2, p. 203 | 843 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 13 | Verbot von Neuaufnahmen in Klöstern 1544 | 1544 | 17/2, p. 204 | 844 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 14 | Mandat zur Religionstoleranz 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 205 | 845 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15 | Verzeichnis der gültigen Feiertage 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 206 | 846 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 16 | Mandat zur Sonn- und Feiertagsheiligung 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 207 | 847 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 17 | Ordnung der Pfarrkonvente 1556 | 1556 | 17/2, p. 208 | 848 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 18 | Verkündzettel zur Visitation des Ulmer Landgebiets 1557 | 1557 | 17/2, p. 217 | 849 | Visitation | L | |
| 19 | Kanzelverkündung gegen Schmähreden auf Evangelium und Obrigkeit 1558 | 1558 | 17/2, p. 219 | 850 | Other | L | |
| 20 | Zuchtordnung 1558 | 1558 | 17/2, p. 220 | 851 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 21 | Ulmer Katechismus des Ludwig Rabus 1561 | 1561 | 17/2, p. 239 | 852 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 22 | Ehegerichtsordnung 1565 | 1565 | 17/2, p. 255 | 853 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 23 | Mandat gegen Wahrsager und Segensprecher 1567 | 1567 | 17/2, p. 269 | 854 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 24 | Anweisungen für Amtsträger im Ulmer Landgebiet 1567 | 1567 | 17/2, p. 270 | 855 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 25 | Mandat zur Eheschließung unter Verwandten 1572 | 1572 | 17/2, p. 275 | 856 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 26 | Kanzelverkündung zur Prüfung der Brautleute 1584 | 1584 | 17/2, p. 276 | 857 | Marriage | L | |
| 27a | Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Bericht der Prediger über die Beichte [1586] | 1586 | 17/2, p. 277 | 858 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 27b | Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Ratsentscheid über den Bericht der Prediger 1586 | 1586 | 17/2, p. 282 | 858 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 27c | Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Bericht der Prediger über die Beichtzeiten 1586 | 1586 | 17/2, p. 283 | 858 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 27d | Berichte und Ratsentscheide zur Einzelbeichte 1586: Ratsentscheid über den Bericht der Prediger 1586 | 1586 | 17/2, p. 285 | 858 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 28 | Resolution zu Schul- und Kirchensachen 1593 | 1593 | 17/2, p. 286 | 859 | School / university | L | |
| 29 | Ulmer Katechismus des Johannes Veesenbeck 1598 | 1598 | 17/2, p. 295 | 860 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 30 | Eheordnung 1600 | 1600 | 17/2, p. 307 | 861 | Marriage | L | |

### 1.26.3 Imperial city of Esslingen

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Blarer) until the Interim; Lutheran after.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 34, Lutheran 6.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ratsverkündung zur Anstellung eines Predigers und Wahrung des innerstädtischen Friedens in der Religionsfrage 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 329 | 864 | Appointment / oath | MR | |
| 2 | Ratsdekret zur Einführung der Reformation 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 331 | 865 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 3 | Verbot, in anderen Orten die Messe zu besuchen 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 333 | 866 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 4 | Verbot, Kleriker und Ordensgeistliche zu beleidigen 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 334 | 867 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 5 | Zuchtordnung 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 335 | 868 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 6 | Neuordnung des Esslinger Pfarrsprengels [1532] | 1532 | 17/2, p. 357 | 869 | Other | MR | |
| 7 | Ordnung der Leibgedinge für Konventualen und Organisation der Barfüßerpfarrei [1532] | 1532 | 17/2, p. 359 | 870 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 8 | Ordnung für die Bezirkszuchtherren 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 361 | 871 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 9 | Aufgaben der Bezirkszuchtherren [1532] | 1532 | 17/2, p. 363 | 872 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 10 | Ratsverkündung gegen die Täufer 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 364 | 873 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 11 | Artikel zu Gottesdienstbesuch und Abendmahlsempfang 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 365 | 874 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 12 | Instruktionen für die Verordneten im Dominikanerkloster 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 370 | 875 | Monastery / chapter | MR | |
| 13 | Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen 1532 | 1532 | 17/2, p. 371 | 876 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 14 | Verordnung für die Zunftherren zur Sonn- und Feiertagsheiligung 1533 | 1533 | 17/2, p. 372 | 877 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 15 | Prädikantenordnung [1533] | 1533 | 17/2, p. 373 | 878 | Other | MR | |
| 16 | Ordnung zur Zusammenziehung der verbliebenen Mönche im Barfüßerkloster [1533] | 1533 | 17/2, p. 376 | 879 | Monastery / chapter | MR | |
| 17 | Ordnung zum Besuch der Predigtgottesdienste 1534 | 1534 | 17/2, p. 378 | 880 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister [1534] | 1534 | 17/2, p. 381 | 881 | Articles / statutes | MR | |
| 19 | Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster 1535 | 1535 | 17/2, p. 382 | 882 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 20 | Mandat zu Eheeinsegnungen 1535 | 1535 | 17/2, p. 384 | 883 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 21a | Reformartikel und Ordnung kirchlicher Belange: Reformartikel 1536 | 1536 | 17/2, p. 385 | 883 | Other | MR | |
| 21b | Reformartikel und Ordnung kirchlicher Belange: Ordnung kirchlicher Belange 1536 | 1536 | 17/2, p. 386 | 883 | Local order | MR | |
| 22a | Mandate zu Sonntagsheiligung und Feiertagen: Gebot der Sonntagsheiligung und Ordnung der Feiertage 1537 | 1537 | 17/2, p. 389 | 883 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 22b | Mandate zu Sonntagsheiligung und Feiertagen: Ordnung der Feiertage [1537] | 1537 | 17/2, p. 390 | 883 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 23 | Protokoll zur Abfindung der Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster 1538 | 1538 | 17/2, p. 391 | 884 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 24 | Artikel zum Kirchen- und Schulwesen 1538 | 1538 | 17/2, p. 392 | 885 | Articles / statutes | MR | |
| 25 | Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst 1540 | 1540 | 17/2, p. 394 | 886 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 26a | Ordnung des Gebetsgottesdiensts: Ratsverkündung für den Gebetsgottesdienst 1542 | 1542 | 17/2, p. 395 | 886 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 26b | Ratssatzung, den Gebetsgottesdienst nicht vorzeitig zu verlassen [1543] | 1543 | 17/2, p. 396 | 886 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 27 | Kanzelverkündung zur Zuchtordnung und Sonntagsheiligung 1543 | 1543 | 17/2, p. 397 | 887 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 28 | Täufermandat 1544 | 1544 | 17/2, p. 399 | 888 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 29 | Kanzelverkündung: Verbot von Rosenkränzen 1544 | 1544 | 17/2, p. 400 | 889 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 30 | Mandat zur Einschärfung der Zuchtordnung 1547 | 1547 | 17/2, p. 401 | 890 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 31 | Mandat zur Verkündung der Brautleute in der Kirche 1547 | 1547 | 17/2, p. 402 | 891 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 32 | Ordnung des Katechismusunterrichts 1551 | 1551 | 17/2, p. 403 | 892 | Catechism / instruction | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 33 | Kanzelverkündung zur Eheschließung unter Verwandten 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 404 | 893 | Marriage | L | |
| 34 | Täufermandat für Möhringen und Vaihingen 1563 | 1563 | 17/2, p. 405 | 894 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 35 | Mandat zur Eheeinsegnung nur mit Zustimmung des Rats 1564 | 1564 | 17/2, p. 408 | 895 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 36 | Kanzelverkündung zur Eheschließungen unter Verwandten 1594 | 1594 | 17/2, p. 409 | 896 | Marriage | L | |
| 37 | Ordnung gegen Hurerei und Ehebruch 1602 | 1602 | 17/2, p. 410 | 897 | Marriage | L | |

#### 1.26.4 Imperial city of Giengen an der Brenz

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Eheordnung 1583 | 1583 | 17/2, p. 423 | 901 | Marriage | L | |

#### 1.26.5 Imperial city of Biberach an der Riß

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Upper German (Zwinglian) until the Interim; biconfessional afterwards.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 3.
- **Interim**: 2 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ratsbeschluss zum Verbot der Messe 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 439 | 905 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 2 | Zucht- und Eheordnung 1531 | 1531 | 17/2, p. 440 | 906 | Marriage | MR | |
| 3 | Ratsmandat für die Prediger zur Gewissensfreiheit nach Annahme des Interims [1548] | 1548 | 17/2, p. 449 | 907 | Mandate / decree | MR | **Interim order**; council's mandate after accepting the Interim |
| 4 | Täufermandat [1549] | 1549 | 17/2, p. 451 | 908 | Discipline / police | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 5 | Feiertagsmandat 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 452 | 909 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 6 | Mandat Kaiser Ferdinands I. zur Biberacher Religionstoleranz 1563 | 1563 | 17/2, p. 453 | 910 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.26.6 Imperial city of Ravensburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: Biconfessional after the Interim.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Beschluss von Rat und Bürgerschaft zur Predigt des Evangeliums 1545 | 1545 | 17/2, p. 471 | 913 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Anweisung zur Abschaffung altgläubiger Zeremonien 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 472 | 914 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Verbot, außerhalb Ravensburgs zur Messe zu gehen 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 473 | 915 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Anweisungen für die altgläubigen Geistlichen 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 474 | 916 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Anweisung zur Residenz der Pfründeninhaber 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 475 | 917 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 6 | Zuchtordnung 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 476 | 918 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 7 | Vertragsauszug zur bikonfessionellen Nutzung der Karmeliterkirche 1554 | 1554 | 17/2, p. 495 | 919 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 8 | Mandate zur Toleranz zwischen den Anhängern verschiedener Konfessionen 1555/85 | 1555 | 17/2, p. 496 | 920 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Lutherisches Abendmahlsbekenntnis 1557 | 1557 | 17/2, p. 498 | 921 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 10 | Konkordie und Kirchenordnung 1578 | 1578 | 17/2, p. 500 | 922 | Church order | L | |
| 11 | Mandat zur Toleranz unter Katholiken und Protestanten 1610 | 1610 | 17/2, p. 506 | 923 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.26.7 Imperial city of Wimpfen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Festsetzung der gültigen Feiertage 1545 | 1545 | 17/2, p. 516 | 926 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 2 | Mandat Kaiser Maximilians II. zur Anstellung evangelischer Prediger 1566 | 1566 | 17/2, p. 517 | 927 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Regelung der Predigtzeiten und Festtage beider Konfessionen 1568 | 1568 | 17/2, p. 519 | 928 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4 | Mandat Kaiser Maximilians II. zur Ausweisung der Evangelischen aus der Pfarrkirche 1570 | 1570 | 17/2, p. 523 | 929 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Vertrag zur Nutzung der Klosterkirche durch die evangeiische Gemeinde [1570] | 1570 | 17/2, p. 527 | 930 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 6 | Vergleich zur Nutzung der Klosterkirche von Anhängern beider Konfessionen 1571 | 1571 | 17/2, p. 529 | 930 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen [nach 1577] | 1577 | 17/2, p. 530 | 930 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 8 | Regelung der Gottesdienstzeiten in der Pfarrkirche 1589 | 1589 | 17/2, p. 531 | 930 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.26.8 Imperial city of Leutkirch

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vertrag zu den Rechten der katholischen und evangelischen Gemeinde 1562 | 1562 | 17/2, p. 540 | 934 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 2 | Ratsentscheid für den Schulmeister 1569 | 1569 | 17/2, p. 543 | 935 | School / university | L | |
| 3 | Dekret für die Prädikanten zum Kalenderstreit 1603 | 1603 | 17/2, p. 544 | 936 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Dekret für die Bürgerschaft zum Kalenderstreit 1603 | 1603 | 17/2, p. 546 | 937 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Vertragsauszug zum Glockenläuten bei Begräbnissen 1605 | 1605 | 17/2, p. 548 | 938 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.26.9 Imperial city of Bopfingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bucherwerb für die Pfarrkirche 1546 | 1546 | 17/2, p. 555 | 941 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Ratsbeschlüsse für die evangelischen Geistlichen 1563/1567 | 1567 | 17/2, p. 556 | 942 | Other | L | |
| 3 | Eingabe der Prediger und Ratsentscheidungen zur Ordnung des kirchlichen Lebens 1607 | 1607 | 17/2, p. 557 | 943 | Other | L | |

#### 1.26.10 Imperial city of Aalen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ratsverkündung und Abstimmung zur Annahme der Confessio Augustana 1575 | 1575 | 17/2, p. 566 | 948 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 2 | Vertrag zur Besoldung der evangelischen Geistlichen 1576 | 1576 | 17/2, p. 569 | 949 | Treaty / agreement | L | |

## 1.27 Volume 18: Rhineland-Palatinate I: Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Veldenz, Sponheim

62 texts.

### 1.27.1 Duchy of Pfalz-Zweibrücken

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1588.
- **Note**: Lutheran until Johann I introduced the Reformed catechism in 1588.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 29, Reformed 13.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 12 Artikel „Form und Maß“ 1533 | 1533 | 18, p. 49 | 963 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Ordnung des Katechismuswesens 1538 | 1538 | 18, p. 54 | 964 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“ 1539 | 1539 | 18, p. 55 | 965 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1539 | 1539 | 18, p. 67 | 966 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung 1557 | 1557 | 18, p. 71 | 967 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Mandat gegen Gotteslästerung 1557 | 1557 | 18, p. 260 | 968 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Mandat zur Kirchenzensur 1558 | 1558 | 18, p. 264 | 969 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Visitationsordnungen 1558 | 1558 | 18, p. 265 | 970 | Visitation | L | |
| 9 | Generalartikel 1560 | 1560 | 18, p. 277 | 971 | Visitation | L | |
| 10 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Volksbräuche 1560 | 1560 | 18, p. 296 | 972 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Feiertagsordnung 1561 | 1561 | 18, p. 297 | 973 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Superintendentenordnung 1562 | 1562 | 18, p. 299 | 974 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 13 | Mandat zur Kirchenrechnung 1562 | 1562 | 18, p. 302 | 975 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14 | Mandat zur Druckzensur 1562 | 1562 | 18, p. 303 | 976 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15 | Ehemandate 1561/1563 | 1563 | 18, p. 304 | 977 | Marriage | L | |
| 16 | Sonntagsmandat 1563 | 1563 | 18, p. 308 | 978 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 17 | Fürbittenmandate 1563/1566 | 1566 | 18, p. 309 | 979 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 18 | Begräbnismandat 1564 | 1564 | 18, p. 314 | 980 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 19 | Mandat gegen die Calvinisten 1564 | 1564 | 18, p. 315 | 981 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 20 | Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener 1564 | 1564 | 18, p. 319 | 982 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 21 | Ordnung für den Generalsuperintendenten 1564 | 1564 | 18, p. 334 | 983 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 22 | Almosenordnung 1565 | 1565 | 18, p. 336 | 984 | Poor relief | L | |
| 23 | Ordnung der Kirchengesänge 1565 | 1565 | 18, p. 337 | 985 | Church order | L | |
| 24 | Pfarrhausmandat 1566 | 1566 | 18, p. 342 | 986 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 25 | Ordinationszeugnis 1567 | 1567 | 18, p. 343 | 987 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 26 | Mandat zur Einhaltung der Kirchenordnung 1570 | 1570 | 18, p. 345 | 988 | Church order | L | |
| 27 | Visitationsordnung 1575 | 1575 | 18, p. 349 | 989 | Visitation | L | |
| 28 | Sonntagsmandate 1577/1592 | 1592 | 18, p. 364 | 990 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 29 | Visitationsformular 1579 | 1579 | 18, p. 367 | 991 | Visitation | L | |
| 30 | Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg 1579 | 1579 | 18, p. 377 | 992 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 31 | Verordnungen zur Einführung des neuen Katechismus 1588 | 1588 | 18, p. 381 | 993 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 32 | Katechismus 1588 | 1588 | 18, p. 384 | 994 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 33 | Synodalordnung 1592 | 1592 | 18, p. 401 | 995 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 34 | Dorfschulmandat 1592 | 1592 | 18, p. 406 | 996 | School / university | R | |
| 35 | Festmandat 1594 | 1594 | 18, p. 408 | 997 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 36 | Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra 1595 | 1595 | 18, p. 410 | 998 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 37 | Visitationsordnung 1597 | 1597 | 18, p. 411 | 999 | Visitation | R | |
| 38 | Eheordnung 1605 | 1605 | 18, p. 414 | 1000 | Marriage | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 39 | Ehebruchmandat 1605 | 1605 | 18, p. 432 | 1001 | Marriage | R | |
| 40 | Mandat betr. Korrekturen zur Kirchenordnung 1605 | 1605 | 18, p. 439 | 1002 | Church order | R | |
| 42 | Pfarrkonventsordnung 1616 | 1616 | 18, p. 441 | 1003 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 43 | Reformationsjubiläum 1617 | 1617 | 18, p. 443 | 1004 | Other | R | |

#### 1.27.2 County of Pfalz-Veldenz with Lützelstein and Guttenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Visitationsordnung 1558 | 1558 | 18, p. 452 | 1007 | Visitation | L | |
| 5 | Feiertagsordnung 1570 | 1570 | 18, p. 457 | 1008 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 6 | Begräbnisordnung 1571 | 1571 | 18, p. 458 | 1009 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Generalartikel 1571 | 1571 | 18, p. 459 | 1010 | Visitation | L | |
| 11 | Kirchenordnung Lützelstein 1605 | 1605 | 18, p. 459 | 1010 | Church order | L | |
| 8 | Kirchenordnung 1574 | 1574 | 18, p. 462 | 1011 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.27.3 Counties of Sponheim

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Reformation in der Vorderen Grafschaft Sponheim | n.d. | 18, p. 628 | 1015 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Visitationsrelation 1560 | 1560 | 18, p. 635 | 1016 | Visitation | L | |
| 4 | Abschaffung katholischer Bräuche 1575 | 1575 | 18, p. 642 | 1017 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Gemeine Punkte [nach 1577] | 1577 | 18, p. 643 | 1018 | Other | L | |
| 7 | Kompetenzordnung [nach 1579] | 1579 | 18, p. 646 | 1019 | Other | L | |
| 8 | Kirchen- und Zensurordnung 1590/91 | 1590 | 18, p. 648 | 1020 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Superintendentenordnung 1592 | 1592 | 18, p. 660 | 1021 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | Generalartikel 1599 | 1599 | 18, p. 662 | 1021 | Visitation | L | |
| 11 | Kirchen- und Zensurordnung 1607 | 1607 | 18, p. 666 | 1021 | Other | L | |
| 12 | Generalartikel 1608 | 1608 | 18, p. 671 | 1021 | Visitation | L | |
| 13 | Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617 | 1617 | 18, p. 684 | 1021 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.27.4 Lordship of Sickingen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Bekenntnis der Kirchendiener [1564] | 1564 | 18, p. 689 | 1024 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung Ebernburg 1572 | 1572 | 18, p. 698 | 1025 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.27.5 County of Manderscheid-Schleiden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | Befehl zur Austeilung des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt 1566 | 1566 | 18, p. 706 | 1028 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.28 Volume 19/1: Rhineland-Palatinate II/1: Landau, Speyer, Worms, Leiningen, Sayn, Wied

61 texts.

#### 1.28.1 Imperial city of Landau

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1555.
- **Note**: Johannes Bader's early Reformation; Strasbourg Lutheranism after 1555.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 7, Moderate Reformed 5.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Katechismus 1526 | 1526 | 19/1, p. 34 | 1039 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 2 | Katechismus 1544 | 1544 | 19/1, p. 45 | 1040 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 3 | Ratsprotokoll zu Fragen der Kirchenordnung 1554 | 1554 | 19/1, p. 57 | 1041 | Church order | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Ratsprotokoll zur Predigt 1554 | 1554 | 19/1, p. 58 | 1042 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 5 | Ratsprotokoll zum Almosen 1554 | 1554 | 19/1, p. 59 | 1043 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 6 | Feiertagsordnung 1562 | 1562 | 19/1, p. 60 | 1044 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 7 | Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch und zur Polizeiordnung 1571 | 1571 | 19/1, p. 62 | 1045 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Verhandlungen gegen Calvinisten 1582 | 1582 | 19/1, p. 65 | 1046 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 9 | Ratsprotokoll wegen des Katechismus 1595 | 1595 | 19/1, p. 66 | 1047 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 10 | Mandat gegen das Schmähen auf der Kanzel 1608 | 1608 | 19/1, p. 67 | 1048 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Ratsprotokoll wegen des Kirchgangs des Magistrats 1610 | 1610 | 19/1, p. 70 | 1049 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Einführung der Straßburger Kirchenzensur 1611 | 1611 | 19/1, p. 71 | 1050 | Other | L | |

### 1.28.2 Imperial city of Speyer

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vertrag zwischen Stadt und Klerus 1525 | 1525 | 19/1, p. 83 | 1054 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 2 | Bedenken der Predigt halben 1538 | 1538 | 19/1, p. 87 | 1055 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Anstellung evangelischer Prediger 1545 | 1545 | 19/1, p. 90 | 1056 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnung 1557 | 1557 | 19/1, p. 91 | 1057 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung 1569 | 1569 | 19/1, p. 94 | 1058 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Vergleich zwischen Stadt und Augustinerorden 1570 | 1570 | 19/1, p. 106 | 1059 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 7 | Ordnung des Katechismuswesens 1597 | 1597 | 19/1, p. 107 | 1060 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 8 | Mandat zum Gottesdienst 1605 | 1605 | 19/1, p. 110 | 1061 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Verbot von Begräbnissen in der Kirche 1608 | 1608 | 19/1, p. 112 | 1062 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 10 | Mandat zur Errichtung eines Konsistoriums und zur Amtsführung der Pfarrer 1612 | 1612 | 19/1, p. 113 | 1063 | Mandate / decree | L | |

#### 1.28.3 Imperial city of Worms

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1552.
- **Note**: Upper German beginnings; Lutheran consolidation after 1552.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 3, Lutheran 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Deutsche Messe 1524 | 1524 | 19/1, p. 124 | 1066 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 2 | Vertrag zwischen Stadt und Klerus 1525 | 1525 | 19/1, p. 130 | 1067 | Treaty / agreement | MR | |
| 3 | Katechismus 1543 | 1543 | 19/1, p. 134 | 1068 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 4 | Agendbüchlein 1560 | 1560 | 19/1, p. 160 | 1069 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

#### 1.28.4 Counties of Leiningen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnungsmandat 1566 | 1566 | 19/1, p. 222 | 1072 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1566 | 1566 | 19/1, p. 225 | 1073 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung 1566 | 1566 | 19/1, p. 230 | 1074 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnungsmandat 1581 | 1581 | 19/1, p. 275 | 1075 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnungsmandat 1584 | 1584 | 19/1, p. 277 | 1076 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch 1587 | 1587 | 19/1, p. 280 | 1077 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Kirchenordnungsmandat [nach 1593] | 1593 | 19/1, p. 281 | 1078 | Church order | L | |
| 8 | Visitationsordnung 1597 | 1597 | 19/1, p. 284 | 1079 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Visitations- und Täuferordnung 1609 | 1609 | 19/1, p. 298 | 1080 | Visitation | L | |
| 10 | Mandat zum Gottesdienstbesuch 1610 | 1610 | 19/1, p. 320 | 1081 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Mandat zum Reformationsjubiläum 1617 | 1617 | 19/1, p. 321 | 1082 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.28.5 County of Sayn

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1605.
- **Note**: Lutheran until the Reformed confession was introduced in 1605.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 13, Reformed 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Anordnung evangelischer Predigt 1560 | 1560 | 19/1, p. 333 | 1085 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1573 | 1573 | 19/1, p. 334 | 1086 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 3 | Mandat zur Anordnung des Pfarrerexamens 1573 | 1573 | 19/1, p. 336 | 1087 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Kirchenordnung 1574 | 1574 | 19/1, p. 337 | 1088 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1575 | 1575 | 19/1, p. 353 | 1089 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Mandat zum Besuch der Gottesdienste 1581 | 1581 | 19/1, p. 357 | 1090 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Mandat zur Einziehung der Kirchenzinsen 1581 | 1581 | 19/1, p. 359 | 1090 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Sendschöffenordnung 1581 | 1581 | 19/1, p. 361 | 1090 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1582 | 1582 | 19/1, p. 362 | 1090 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Mandat zur Aufsicht über die kirchlichen Gebäude 1582 | 1582 | 19/1, p. 376 | 1090 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Protokoll des Konsistoriums 1582 | 1582 | 19/1, p. 377 | 1090 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 12 | Almosenordnung 1587 | 1587 | 19/1, p. 379 | 1090 | Poor relief | L | |
| 13 | Kirchenordnung 1590 | 1590 | 19/1, p. 385 | 1090 | Church order | L | |
| 14 | Sendschöffenordnung 1606 | 1606 | 19/1, p. 449 | 1090 | Other | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 15 | Visitationsartikel 1609 | 1609 | 19/1, p. 453 | 1090 | Visitation | R | |
| 16 | Kirchenordnungsmandat 1619 | 1619 | 19/1, p. 454 | 1090 | Church order | R | |

#### 1.28.6 County of Wied

- **Tradition**: Reformed.
- **Note**: The synod of 1564 already prescribes the Heidelberg Catechism.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Synodalbeschlüsse 1564 | 1564 | 19/1, p. 465 | 1094 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 2 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1590 | 1590 | 19/1, p. 469 | 1095 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 3 | Synodalbeschluss zur Pfarrwitwenversorgung [1592] | 1592 | 19/1, p. 473 | 1096 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 4 | Synodalbeschlüsse 1593 | 1593 | 19/1, p. 474 | 1097 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 5 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1600 | 1600 | 19/1, p. 476 | 1098 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 6 | Synodalbeschlüsse 1602 / 1609 | 1609 | 19/1, p. 490 | 1099 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 7 | Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung 1616 | 1616 | 19/1, p. 492 | 1100 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 8 | Visitationsartikel 1619 | 1619 | 19/1, p. 509 | 1101 | Visitation | R | |

### 1.29 Volume 19/2: Rhineland-Palatinate II/2: Wild- and Rhinegraviate, Simmern; supplements

98 texts.

#### 1.29.1 Wild- and Rhinegraviate

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenzuchtordnung 1563 | 1563 | 19/2, p. 532 | 1106 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 2 | Reformationsmandat Vinstingen 1565 | 1565 | 19/2, p. 537 | 1107 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Synodalprotokoll 1568 | 1568 | 19/2, p. 539 | 1108 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Superintendentenordnungen 1576/1584 | 1584 | 19/2, p. 542 | 1109 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Erster Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1584 | 1584 | 19/2, p. 549 | 1110 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 7 | Visitationsmandat 1584 | 1584 | 19/2, p. 552 | 1111 | Visitation | L | |
| 8 | Entlassungszeugnis 1586 | 1586 | 19/2, p. 553 | 1112 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Zweiter Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1596 | 1596 | 19/2, p. 554 | 1113 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 10 | Pestordnung 1597 | 1597 | 19/2, p. 556 | 1114 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 11 | Visitationsordnung [ca. 1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 558 | 1115 | Visitation | L | |
| 12 | Pfarrkonventsordnung [ca. 1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 560 | 1116 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 13 | Superintendentenordnung [1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 563 | 1117 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 14 | Ordinationsordnung [1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 568 | 1118 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 15 | Patenordnung [1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 573 | 1118 | Other | L | |
| 16 | Ratifikationsordnung [1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 579 | 1118 | Other | L | |
| 17 | Kirchenzuchtordnung [1597] | 1597 | 19/2, p. 581 | 1118 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 18 | Dienstanweisung für Pfarrer 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 583 | 1118 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 19 | Zensorenordnung [um 1600] | 1600 | 19/2, p. 585 | 1119 | Other | L | |
| 20 | Kirchmeistereid [um 1600] | 1600 | 19/2, p. 587 | 1120 | Other | L | |
| 21 | Kirchenordnung [nach 1603] | 1603 | 19/2, p. 588 | 1121 | Church order | L | |
| 22 | Pestordnung 1612 | 1612 | 19/2, p. 645 | 1122 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 22 | Dritter Vertrag über die Konfession der Herrschaft Vinstingen 1618 | 1618 | 19/2, p. 648 | 1122 | Treaty / agreement | L | |

### 1.29.2 Principality of Pfalz-Simmern

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1598. Duke Reichard held to the Augsburg Confession until his death on 14 January 1598, when the principality fell to the Electoral Palatinate. The two mandates of 1598 were issued from Heidelberg under Elector Frederick IV, and the first ordered the churches cleared "im reformierten Sinne" (Sehling 19/2, p. 656).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Klosterordnung 1560 | 1560 | 19/2, p. 657 | 1125 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 2 | Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre 1598 | 1598 | 19/2, p. 661 | 1126 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 3 | Mandat zur geistlichen Güterverwaltung 1598 | 1598 | 19/2, p. 662 | 1127 | Mandate / decree | R | |

#### 1.29.3 County of Pfalz-Veldenz (supplement to vol. 18)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Generalartikel 1571 | 1571 | 19/2, p. 666 | 1130 | Visitation | L | |

#### 1.29.4 Electoral Palatinate (supplement to vol. 14)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1561; Lutheran from 1577, save in Johann Casimir's Reformed Pfalz-Lautern (nos. 8, 9 and 11); Reformed from 1583.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 65, Lutheran 7.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Verbot der katholischen Messe 1546 | 1546 | 19/2, p. 715 | 1134 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenregimentsordnung 1577 | 1577 | 19/2, p. 716 | 1135 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 3 | Visitationsbedenken [März 1578] | 1578 | 19/2, p. 720 | 1136 | Visitation | L | |
| 4 | Superintendentenordnung 1580 | 1580 | 19/2, p. 723 | 1137 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenbußordnung [1579] | 1579 | 19/2, p. 734 | 1138 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 6 | Kirchenbußordnung 1580 | 1580 | 19/2, p. 739 | 1139 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 7 | Verordnung von Senioren [1581] | 1581 | 19/2, p. 748 | 1140 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Eid der Kirchenschaffner Mai 1577 | 1577 | 19/2, p. 749 | 1141 | Appointment / oath | R | Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern; sworn also to Ludwig VI |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 | Stiftung der Neustädter Hochschule 1578 | 1578 | 19/2, p. 750 | 1142 | School / university | R | Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern |
| 11 | Mandat zu den Bettagen 1580 | 1580 | 19/2, p. 754 | 1143 | Mandate / decree | R | Johann Casimir in Pfalz-Lautern; no. 10 in the editor's introduction |
| 11 | Huldigung der Kirchendiener 1585 | 1585 | 19/2, p. 756 | 1143 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 12 | Mandat zur Einhaltung der Kirchenordnung 1587 | 1587 | 19/2, p. 757 | 1144 | Church order | R | |
| 13 | Mandat zur Einhaltung der Polizeiordnung 1588 | 1588 | 19/2, p. 759 | 1145 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 14 | Ordnung des Waisenhauses zu Handschuhsheim 1588 | 1588 | 19/2, p. 761 | 1146 | Poor relief | R | |
| 15 | Mandat zur Aufsicht der Amtleute über die Kirchendiener 1589 | 1589 | 19/2, p. 769 | 1147 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 16 | Mandat zur Aufsicht der Inspektoren über die Kirchendiener 1589 | 1589 | 19/2, p. 770 | 1148 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 17 | Mandat zu den Bettagen 1590 | 1590 | 19/2, p. 771 | 1149 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 18 | Ordnung des Sondersiechenhauses in Neuenheim 1591 | 1591 | 19/2, p. 772 | 1150 | Poor relief | R | |
| 19 | Mandat zu den Bettagen 1591 | 1591 | 19/2, p. 777 | 1151 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 20 | Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1591 | 1591 | 19/2, p. 780 | 1152 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 21 | Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1592 | 1592 | 19/2, p. 785 | 1153 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 22 | Ordnung der Senioren 1592 | 1592 | 19/2, p. 787 | 1154 | Local order | R | |
| 23 | Einführung der Senioren 1592 | 1592 | 19/2, p. 789 | 1155 | Other | R | |
| 24 | Ordnung der Ordination [1592] | 1592 | 19/2, p. 791 | 1156 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 25 | Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener [1592] | 1592 | 19/2, p. 793 | 1157 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 26 | Mandat über Druckzensur 1593 | 1593 | 19/2, p. 795 | 1158 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 27 | Ankündigung der Visitation 1593 | 1593 | 19/2, p. 797 | 1159 | Visitation | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 28 | Muster der Institution [1593] | 1593 | 19/2, p. 804 | 1160 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 29 | Visitationsabschied 1593 | 1593 | 19/2, p. 812 | 1161 | Visitation | R | |
| 30 | Generalvisitationsinstruktion 1594 | 1594 | 19/2, p. 822 | 1162 | Visitation | R | |
| 31 | Spitalordnung zu Heidelberg 1594 | 1594 | 19/2, p. 825 | 1163 | Poor relief | R | |
| 32 | Patent auf die Generalvisitation 1594 | 1594 | 19/2, p. 840 | 1164 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 33 | Visitationsbericht [1594] | 1594 | 19/2, p. 842 | 1165 | Visitation | R | |
| 34 | Mandat zur Institution 1594 | 1594 | 19/2, p. 854 | 1166 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 35 | Mandat zur Institution und Sonntagsheiligung 1595 | 1595 | 19/2, p. 855 | 1167 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 36 | Mandat zur Institution [1595] | 1595 | 19/2, p. 865 | 1168 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 37 | Mandat zur Institution und Polizeiordnung 1595 | 1595 | 19/2, p. 869 | 1169 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 38 | Mandat zu Leben, Lehre und Wandel der Kirchendiener | 1596 | 19/2, p. 872 | 1170 | Mandate / decree | R | dated 15 April 1596 in the text |
| 39 | Predigtmandat 1596 | 1596 | 19/2, p. 873 | 1171 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 40 | Mandat zur Amtsführung der Kirchendiener 1597 | 1597 | 19/2, p. 875 | 1172 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 41 | Visitationsinstruktion für die Nebenvisitatoren 1597 | 1597 | 19/2, p. 876 | 1173 | Visitation | R | |
| 42 | Mandat zur Druckzensur 1598 | 1598 | 19/2, p. 889 | 1174 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 43 | Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht u.a. 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 890 | 1175 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 44 | Mandat zum Katechimusunterricht 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 892 | 1176 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 45 | Spitalordnung zu Branchweiler 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 893 | 1177 | Poor relief | R | |
| 46 | Spitalordnung zu Germersheim [ca. 1599] | 1599 | 19/2, p. 902 | 1178 | Poor relief | R | |
| 47 | Mandat zur Institution 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 910 | 1179 | Mandate / decree | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 48 | Mandat zu Almosen und Fürbitte 1599 | 1599 | 19/2, p. 912 | 1180 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 49 | Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1600 | 1600 | 19/2, p. 913 | 1181 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 50 | Punkte zur Almosenordnung 1600 | 1600 | 19/2, p. 914 | 1182 | Poor relief | R | |
| 51 | Heidelberger Punkte zur Almosenordnung 1600 | 1600 | 19/2, p. 917 | 1183 | Poor relief | R | |
| 52 | Mandat zu Predigt, Pfarrbesoldung, Schutz der Gottesdienste und Almosenordnung 1600 | 1600 | 19/2, p. 920 | 1184 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 53 | Ordnung der Classicalconvente [nach 1598 - vor 1607] | 1607 | 19/2, p. 922 | 1185 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 54 | Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1601 | 1601 | 19/2, p. 933 | 1186 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 55 | Mandat zum Pfarrstellenwechsel 1601 | 1601 | 19/2, p. 934 | 1187 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 56 | Mandat zur Almosenordnung 1601 | 1601 | 19/2, p. 938 | 1188 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 57 | Mandat zur Institution 1602 | 1602 | 19/2, p. 939 | 1189 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 58 | Mandat zur Abschaffung des Bettels 1603 | 1603 | 19/2, p. 941 | 1190 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 59 | Mandat zur Anstellung von Schul- und Kirchendienern 1603 | 1603 | 19/2, p. 944 | 1191 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 60 | Ergänzung der Polizeiordnung 1604 | 1604 | 19/2, p. 945 | 1192 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 61 | Mandat zur Polizeiordnung 1604 | 1604 | 19/2, p. 954 | 1193 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 62 | Mandat zur Aufsicht über die Kirchendiener und die Institution 1604 | 1604 | 19/2, p. 955 | 1194 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 63 | Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen 1607 | 1607 | 19/2, p. 956 | 1195 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 64 | Mandat zu den Konventen 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 958 | 1196 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 65 | Mandat zur Institution 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 959 | 1197 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 66 | Toleranzmandat für katholische Untertanen 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 960 | 1198 | Mandate / decree | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 67 | Mandat zur Visitation 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 961 | 1199 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 68 | Mandat zur Institution 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 963 | 1200 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 69 | Mandat zur Institution 1608 | 1608 | 19/2, p. 964 | 1201 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 70 | Mandat zu den Konventen Dezember 1609 | 1609 | 19/2, p. 965 | 1202 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 71 | Mandat zu den Konventen 1610 | 1610 | 19/2, p. 966 | 1203 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 72 | Mandat zu den Bußtagen 1610 | 1610 | 19/2, p. 968 | 1204 | Mandate / decree | R | |

## 1.30 Volume 20/1: Alsace I: Strasbourg

79 texts.

### 1.30.1 Imperial city of Strasbourg

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Lutheran from 1549.
- **Note**: Bucer's church (Upper German, Moderate Reformed) until the Interim; Lutheran orthodoxy under Marbach afterwards (order of 1598).
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 46, Lutheran 33.
- **Interim**: 5 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1a | Armenordnung, längere Fassung 4. August 1523 | 1523 | 20/1, p. 107 | 1276 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 1b | Armenordnung, kürzere Fassung [1. Oktober] 1523 | 1523 | 20/1, p. 115 | 1277 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 2 | Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums 1. Dezember 1523 | 1523 | 20/1, p. 118 | 1278 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 3a | Handschriftliche Agende mit der Deutschen Messe von Theobald Schwarz und Formularen für die Taufe und die Trauung 1524 | 1524 | 20/1, p. 120 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3b | Die frühen Agenden: Teutsche Mess und Tauf 1524 | 1524 | 20/1, p. 130 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3c | Die frühen Agenden: Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess 1524 | 1524 | 20/1, p. 135 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3d | Teutsch Kirchenampt mit lobgsengen und götlichen psalmen [1524/1525] | 1525 | 20/1, p. 136 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3e | Die frühen Agenden: Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal 1525 | 1525 | 20/1, p. 142 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3f | Die frühen Agenden: Straßburger kirchen ampt Mai 1525 | 1525 | 20/1, p. 151 | 1279 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 3g | Die frühen Agenden: Psalmen gebett und kirchen übung 1526 | 1526 | 20/1, p. 163 | 1280 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 4 | Verbot der konkubinarischen Verbindungen 15. März 1525 | 1525 | 20/1, p. 165 | 1281 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 5 | Mandat über Bilder und Altäre 18. März 1525 | 1525 | 20/1, p. 166 | 1282 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 6 | Mandat gegen die Täufer 27. Juli 1527 | 1527 | 20/1, p. 167 | 1283 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 7 | Verbot der Bestattungen in Kirchen und auf Kirchhöfen 8. August 1527 | 1527 | 20/1, p. 169 | 1284 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 8 | Der erste Straßburger Katechismus: Wolfgang Capitos „Kinder bericht“ 1527 | 1527 | 20/1, p. 170 | 1285 | Catechism / instruction | MR | |
| 9a | Vortrag des Magistrats wegen der Abschaffung der Messe [9. Januar 1529] | 1529 | 20/1, p. 202 | 1286 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 9b | Beschluß über die Abschaffung der Messe 20. Februar 1529 | 1529 | 20/1, p. 207 | 1287 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 10 | Zuchtordnung „Constitution und Satzung“ 25. August 1529 | 1529 | 20/1, p. 208 | 1288 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 11 | Eheordnung [19. Februar 1530] | 1530 | 20/1, p. 218 | 1289 | Marriage | MR | |
| 12 | Armenordnung 8. März 1531 | 1531 | 20/1, p. 222 | 1290 | Poor relief | MR | |
| 13 | Verbot, an anderen Orten die Messe zu hören 3. April 1531 | 1531 | 20/1, p. 224 | 1291 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 14 | Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger 30. Oktober 1531 | 1531 | 20/1, p. 225 | 1292 | Church order | MR | |
| 15 | Mandat zum Besuch der Gottesdienste durch die Jugend und das Gesinde [22. April] 1532 | 1532 | 20/1, p. 227 | 1293 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 16 | Anordnung eines Bettags wegen der Bedrohung durch die Osmanen 24. August 1532 | 1532 | 20/1, p. 228 | 1294 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 17 | Kirchenordnung [24. Juni] 1534 | 1534 | 20/1, p. 230 | 1295 | Church order | MR | |
| 18 | Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung 28. Dezember 1534 | 1534 | 20/1, p. 246 | 1296 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 19a | Disziplinarordnung 7. Februar 1535 | 1535 | 20/1, p. 248 | 1297 | Other | MR | |
| 19b | Anweisung zur Taufe der Kinder 8. und 9. Februar 1535 | 1535 | 20/1, p. 254 | 1298 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | Statuten des Predigerkollegs [Vor 29. März 1535] | 1535 | 20/1, p. 255 | 1299 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 21 | Mandat zur Bekämpfung der Irrlehren und zur Stärkung der Kirchenzucht in den Gemeinden auf dem Land 28. April 1535 | 1535 | 20/1, p. 258 | 1300 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 22 | Hochzeitsmandat 12. Februar 1537 | 1537 | 20/1, p. 261 | 1301 | Marriage | MR | |
| 23 | Agende 1537 / 1541 | 1541 | 20/1, p. 262 | 1302 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 24a | Mandat gegen die Täufer 23. März 1538 | 1538 | 20/1, p. 283 | 1303 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 24b | Täuferartikel 23. März 1538 | 1538 | 20/1, p. 286 | 1304 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 25 | Mandat zur Vorladung vor die Kirchenpfleger 29. Januar 1539 | 1539 | 20/1, p. 288 | 1305 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 26a | Munizipalstatut, lateinische Fassung [Vor 9. September 1539] | 1539 | 20/1, p. 290 | 1306 | Other | MR | |
| 26b | Munizipalstatut, deutsche Fassung 9. September 1539 | 1539 | 20/1, p. 296 | 1307 | Other | MR | |
| 27a | Examensordnung, lateinische Fassung [Nach 9. September 1539] | 1539 | 20/1, p. 300 | 1308 | Other | MR | |
| 27b | Examensordnung, deutsche Fassung 1540 | 1540 | 20/1, p. 316 | 1309 | Other | MR | |
| 28 | Bettagsmandat 24. September 1541 | 1541 | 20/1, p. 324 | 1310 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 29 | Gottesdienstordnung [Nach 18. November] 1542 | 1542 | 20/1, p. 325 | 1311 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 30 | Synodaldekrete [11. August 1544] | 1544 | 20/1, p. 332 | 1312 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 31 | Weisung des Magistrats an den Kirchenkonvent, zu Buße und Beständigkeit im Glauben aufzurufen 17. Juni 1546 | 1546 | 20/1, p. 344 | 1313 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 32 | Bettagsmandat für die Pfarreien auf dem Land [Nach 21. Juli 1546] | 1546 | 20/1, p. 345 | 1314 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 33 | Mandat zur Kirchenzucht 29. Januar 1548 | 1548 | 20/1, p. 347 | 1315 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 34 | Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung [Nach 2. Juli] 1548 | 1548 | 20/1, p. 352 | 1316 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | **On the Interim** |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 35 | Agende für die Taufe und Trauung 27. Juni 1549 | 1549 | 20/1, p. 357 | 1317 | Agenda / liturgy | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 36 | Examensordnung 1549 | 1549 | 20/1, p. 364 | 1318 | Other | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 37a | Schiedsvertrag zwischen dem Bischof von Straßburg und dem Magistrat der Stadt über die Durchführung des Interims 23. November 1549 | 1549 | 20/1, p. 368 | 1319 | Treaty / agreement | L | **Interim settlement**; agreement with the bishop over the Interim |
| 37b | Mandat zum Schutz des katholischen Gottesdienstes [4. Februar 1550] | 1550 | 20/1, p. 372 | 1320 | Mandate / decree | L | **Under the Interim** |
| 38 | Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach 21. Juli 1553 / [Zwischen 21. Juli und 26. August 1557] | 1557 | 20/1, p. 373 | 1321 | Church order | L | |
| 39 | Stellungnahme der Straßburger Geistlichen zum Entwurf der Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach 26. August 1557 | 1557 | 20/1, p. 446 | 1322 | Church order | L | |
| 40 | Mandat zu den noch bestehenden Frauenklöstern 18. November 1555 | 1555 | 20/1, p. 453 | 1323 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 41 | Entscheidung des Magistrats über den Frankfurter Rezeß [Nach 27. Juni 1558] | 1558 | 20/1, p. 458 | 1324 | Other | L | |
| 42 | Erlaubnis des Magistrats zur Inbesitznahme des Münsters und der Kirche Jung St. Peter für den evangelischen Gottesdienst 17. Mai 1561 | 1561 | 20/1, p. 460 | 1325 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 43 | Gottesdienstordnung für das Münster [1561-1578] | 1578 | 20/1, p. 461 | 1326 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 44 | Weisung des Magistrats an den Kirchenkonvent wegen strittiger Fragen 13. Juli 1562 | 1562 | 20/1, p. 466 | 1327 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 45 | Entscheidung des Magistrats zur Konfession der Stadt 10. März 1563 | 1563 | 20/1, p. 469 | 1328 | Other | L | |
| 46 | Die Straßburger Konkordie 18. März 1563 | 1563 | 20/1, p. 470 | 1329 | Other | L | |
| 47 | Mandat zu den großen und kleinen Bettagen 11. Oktober 1564 | 1564 | 20/1, p. 476 | 1330 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 48 | Eheordnung 22. Oktober 1565 | 1565 | 20/1, p. 478 | 1331 | Marriage | L | |
| 49 | Bekenntniserklärung der Straßburger Geistlichen vor der Übernahme eines Amtes 1565 | 1565 | 20/1, p. 480 | 1332 | Confession / doctrine | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 50 | Große Zuchtordnung 11. November 1573 | 1573 | 20/1, p. 490 | 1333 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 51 | Entscheidung zum Titel des Superintendenten 6. Januar 1574 | 1574 | 20/1, p. 499 | 1334 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 52 | Vereinbarung zwischen dem Kirchen- und dem Akademiekonvent [31. Dezember 1575] | 1575 | 20/1, p. 502 | 1335 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 53 | Gottesdienstordnung [Nach August 1577] | 1577 | 20/1, p. 512 | 1336 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 54 | Mandat gegen Schmähschriften und -reden 22. April 1581 | 1581 | 20/1, p. 519 | 1337 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 55 | Zwei Ordnungen für die Kirchenpfleger der Gemeinden der Straßburger Landschaft 23. April 1582 | 1582 | 20/1, p. 521 | 1338 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 56 | Gebet wegen der Verfolgung der Protestanten [1585/1586] | 1586 | 20/1, p. 523 | 1339 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 57 | Kirchenordnung für die Pfarreien auf dem Land 24. April 1588 | 1588 | 20/1, p. 525 | 1340 | Church order | L | |
| 58 | Ordnung der Sonn- und Bettage 15. März 1589 | 1589 | 20/1, p. 528 | 1341 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 59 | Ehegerichtsordnung 25. Juni 1589 | 1589 | 20/1, p. 531 | 1342 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 60 | Verbot der Konventikel und des auswärtigen Gottesdienstbesuchs 10. Dezember 1597 | 1597 | 20/1, p. 535 | 1343 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 61 | Kirchenordnung 9. April 1598 | 1598 | 20/1, p. 537 | 1344 | Church order | L | |
| 62 | Stellungnahme des Magistrats zur Anfrage des Kirchenkonvents wegen der reformierten Taufpaten und anderer Themen 28. März 1601 | 1601 | 20/1, p. 700 | 1345 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 63 | Verfügung des Magistrats zu den Predigten bei Begräbnissen 29. April 1609 | 1609 | 20/1, p. 701 | 1346 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 64 | Mandat zur Beseitigung von Mißbräuchen beim Gottesdienstbesuch 19. Juni 1616 | 1616 | 20/1, p. 703 | 1347 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 65a | Anordnung des Magistrats zur Feier des Reformationsjubiläums 15. Oktober 1617 | 1617 | 20/1, p. 704 | 1348 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 65b | Gebete zum Reformationsjubiläum [Zwischen 15. Oktober und 1. | 1617 | 20/1, p. 707 | 1349 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | November 1617] | | | | | | |

## 1.31 Volume 20/2: Alsace II: territories and imperial cities

84 texts.

### 1.31.1 County of Hanau-Lichtenberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Acht Reformationsartikel 14. März [15]45 | n.d. | 20/2, p. 37 | 1359 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Verpflichtung der Geistlichen zur Teilnahme an der ersten Synode [14. Mai] 1545 | 1545 | 20/2, p. 39 | 1360 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 3 | Eheordnung 2. April 1565 | 1565 | 20/2, p. 40 | 1361 | Marriage | L | |
| 4 | Befehl zur Unterdrückung der Messe 17. September 1570 | 1570 | 20/2, p. 46 | 1362 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Verpflichtungserklärung der Pfarrer bei ihrem Amtsantritt 1570 | 1570 | 20/2, p. 47 | 1363 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 6 | Kirchenordnung 1573 | 1573 | 20/2, p. 48 | 1364 | Church order | L | |
| 7 | Schulordnung 1614 | 1614 | 20/2, p. 82 | 1365 | School / university | L | |

### 1.31.2 Lordship of Fleckenstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Zuchtmandat [ohne Datum] | n.d. | 20/2, p. 107 | 1370 | Discipline / police | L | |

### 1.31.3 Lordship of Rappoltstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Note**: The French refugee congregation in the Lebertal was Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 10, Lutheran 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Schulordnung für Rappoltsweiler [ca. 1565 bzw. vor 17. Dezember 1567] | 1567 | 20/2, p. 109 | 1370 | School / university | L | |
| 3 | Zuchtordnung [um 1553] | 1553 | 20/2, p. 112 | 1370 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | Bekenntnis der französischen Gemeinde im Lebertal [1558] | 1558 | 20/2, p. 117 | 1370 | Confession / doctrine | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 5 | Ordnung für das Prebyterium [1558 / 1559] | 1559 | 20/2, p. 123 | 1370 | Local order | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 6 | Bericht des Predigers Pierre Marboeuf über die Lehre der französischen Gemeinde [1560] | 1560 | 20/2, p. 125 | 1370 | Mandate / decree | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 7 | Vergleich zwischen der deutschen und der französischen Gemeinde 28. Mai 1561 | 1561 | 20/2, p. 132 | 1370 | Treaty / agreement | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 8 | Bericht des Predigers Arnaud Banc über die Lehre der französischen Gemeinde [Ende Juni / Anfang Juli 1561] | 1561 | 20/2, p. 136 | 1371 | Mandate / decree | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 9a | Bekenntnis des Predigers der französischen Gemeinde Nicolas François 16. Juli 1562 | 1562 | 20/2, p. 146 | 1371 | Confession / doctrine | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 9b | Revers des Predigers 17. Juli 1562 | 1562 | 20/2, p. 147 | 1371 | Appointment / oath | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 9c | Vom Prediger abgelehnte Artikel [27. Juli 1562] | 1562 | 20/2, p. 148 | 1371 | Other | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 10a | Verpflichtungserklärung für den Prediger der französischen Gemeinde [1569] | 1569 | 20/2, p. 149 | 1371 | Appointment / oath | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |
| 10b | Bestallungsurkunde für den Prediger 1569 | 1569 | 20/2, p. 150 | 1371 | Appointment / oath | R | French Reformed congregation in the Lebertal |

#### 1.31.4 Imperial city of Mülhausen (Mulhouse)

- **Tradition**: Reformed.
- **Note**: Allied with the Swiss; a Zwinglian, later Swiss Reformed, church.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums 25. bzw. 29. Juli 1523 | 1523 | 20/2, p. 187 | 1375 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 2 | Zuchtordnung [Ende 1523 / Anfang 1524] | 1524 | 20/2, p. 189 | 1376 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 3a | Bittschrift der Zunftmeister betreffend die Versorgung des Prädikanten, die Verwendung der deutschen Sprache im Gottesdienst und andere Themen [vor … | 1524 | 20/2, p. 191 | 1376 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3b | Stellungnahme des Rates zu den Forderungen der neuen Zunftmeister [nach 11. Januar 1524] | 1524 | 20/2, p. 193 | 1376 | Other | R | |
| 4 | Verordnungen zu den Prozessionen und Feiertagen [vor 28. April 1524] | 1524 | 20/2, p. 195 | 1377 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 5 | Anweisungen für den Schulmeister und die Kapläne 28. April 1524 | 1524 | 20/2, p. 197 | 1378 | School / university | R | |
| 6a | Anfrage des Komturs des Deutschordenshauses zur Tätigkeit des Leutpriesters 27. Juli [1524] | 1524 | 20/2, p. 199 | 1378 | Other | R | |
| 6b | Stellungnahme des Rates zur Anfrage des Komturs [nach 27. Juli 1524] | 1524 | 20/2, p. 202 | 1378 | Other | R | |
| 7 | Rechtfertigung der reformatorischen Neuerungen durch den Magistrat 1. Juli 1527 | 1527 | 20/2, p. 204 | 1379 | Other | R | |
| 8 | Im Auftrag des Rates erstelltes Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der beiden Prädikanten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche [März 1528] | 1528 | 20/2, p. 206 | 1380 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 9 | Im Auftrag des Rates erstelltes Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der drei Prädikanten zur Gestaltung der Gottesdienste [vor 24. Dezember 1528] | 1528 | 20/2, p. 208 | 1381 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 10 | Gutachten des Leutpriesters und der Prädikanten zu den ihnen vorgelegten Basler und Straßburger Ordnungen [um den 26. November 1529] | 1529 | 20/2, p. 213 | 1382 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 11 | Eheordnung [1530 / 1534] | 1534 | 20/2, p. 218 | 1383 | Marriage | R | |
| 12 | Entscheidung zur Wittenberger Konkordie 9. November 1536 | 1536 | 20/2, p. 225 | 1384 | Other | R | |
| 13 | Mandat zur Predigt des Evangeliums und zur Unterbindung verschiedener Mißbräuche Januar 1537 | 1537 | 20/2, p. 227 | 1385 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 14 | Bekenntnis der Stadt Mülhausen [21. Januar ?] 1537 | 1537 | 20/2, p. 229 | 1386 | Confession / doctrine | R | |
| 15 | Stellungnahme der Geistlichen zu der ihnen vorgelegten Basler Synodalordnung 25. Dezember 1540 | 1540 | 20/2, p. 235 | 1387 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 16 | Beschluß zur Aufrichtung einer christlichen Ordnung 26. Januar 1541 | 1541 | 20/2, p. 241 | 1388 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 17 | Zuchtordnung 12. November 1545 | 1545 | 20/2, p. 245 | 1389 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 18a | Eide der Prädikanten und des Schulmeisters: Eid der Prädikanten 1551 | 1551 | 20/2, p. 248 | 1390 | Appointment / oath | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18b | Eide der Prädikanten und des Schulmeisters: Eid des Schulmeisters 1551 | 1551 | 20/2, p. 251 | 1390 | School / university | R | |
| 19 | Eheordnung 1555 | 1555 | 20/2, p. 253 | 1391 | Marriage | R | |
| 20 | Anweisung an die Prädikanten 24. Juni 1557 | 1557 | 20/2, p. 260 | 1392 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 21 | Sonntagsmandat 30. April 1561 | 1561 | 20/2, p. 264 | 1393 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 22 | Agende 1564 | 1564 | 20/2, p. 268 | 1394 | Agenda / liturgy | R | |
| 23 | Katechismus 1580 | 1580 | 20/2, p. 284 | 1395 | Catechism / instruction | R | |
| 24 | Zuchtordnung 18. März 1582 | 1582 | 20/2, p. 305 | 1396 | Discipline / police | R | |

#### 1.31.5 Imperial city of Weißenburg (Alsace)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vertrag zwischen dem Stift und der Stadt Weißenburg 12. April 1560 | 1560 | 20/2, p. 317 | 1399 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 2 | Zuchtordnung 10. Dezember 1613 | 1613 | 20/2, p. 320 | 1399 | Discipline / police | L | |

#### 1.31.6 Münster im Gregoriental

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kientzheimer Vertrag 19. März 1575 | 1575 | 20/2, p. 353 | 1402 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung [26. August bzw. 4. September 1575 / nach 9. August 1580] | 1580 | 20/2, p. 369 | 1402 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Ordnung für das Ehegericht 1577 | 1577 | 20/2, p. 383 | 1402 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 4 | Mandat zum Kirchenbann 13. September 1578 | 1578 | 20/2, p. 388 | 1402 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Ordnung für die Schulmeister 31. Oktober 1578 | 1578 | 20/2, p. 393 | 1402 | School / university | L | |
| 6 | Sittenmandat 24. Juni 1580 | 1580 | 20/2, p. 396 | 1402 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | Anweisung des Rates zu den Predigten 3. November 1604 | 1604 | 20/2, p. 398 | 1402 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.31.7 Imperial city of Hagenau

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mitteilung über die Einführung des evangelischen Gottesdienstes und die Anstellung eines evangelischen Pfarrers [9. November 1565] | 1565 | 20/2, p. 421 | 1405 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Bestellung eines evangelischen Pfarrers 9. November 1565 | 1565 | 20/2, p. 425 | 1405 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 3 | Vorrede Jakob Andreäs zur Sammlung seiner in Hagenau bei Einführung der Reformation gehaltenen Predigten 24. Juni 1566 | 1566 | 20/2, p. 429 | 1405 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Brief der Stadt Hagenau an Kaiser Maximilian II. zur Rechtfertigung der Einführung der Reformation [nach 22. Oktober 1566] | 1566 | 20/2, p. 435 | 1405 | Other | L | |
| 5 | Zuchtordnung 29. Oktober 1571 | 1571 | 20/2, p. 441 | 1405 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 6 | Vereinbarung zwischen der Stadt Hagenau und der Reichslandvogtei in Religionsfragen 26. Juli 1578 | 1578 | 20/2, p. 448 | 1405 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 7 | Mandat gegen Kuppelei und heimliche Eheabsprachen 22. Februar 1587 | 1587 | 20/2, p. 452 | 1405 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 3. Juni 1588 | 1588 | 20/2, p. 454 | 1405 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Erklärung der evangelischen Ratsmitglieder 11. / 21. April 1603 | 1603 | 20/2, p. 455 | 1405 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 10 | Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 5. April 1610 | 1610 | 20/2, p. 461 | 1405 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Fundationsbrief der evangelischen Kirche und Schule in Hagenau 3. Juni 1614 | 1614 | 20/2, p. 463 | 1405 | School / university | L | |
| 12 | Verbot jeglicher Angriffe und Diskussionen wegen der Religion 8. Mai 1617 | 1617 | 20/2, p. 466 | 1405 | Mandate / decree | L | |

### 1.31.8 Imperial city of Colmar

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Moderate Reformed from 1578.
- **Note**: The Reformation came in 1575 with pastors from Basel (Serinus, on Simon Sulzer's advice) and the Württemberg agenda; Colmar refused the Formula of Concord (1578), and by the early 17th century its church was Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 12, Lutheran 4.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Gutachten des Straßburger Syndikus Johannes Nervius zur Einführung der Reformation Mai 1575 | 1575 | 20/2, p. 491 | 1408 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Eid der Prediger [22. Oktober 1575] | 1575 | 20/2, p. 501 | 1408 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 3 | Feiertagsmandat 22. Oktober 1575 | 1575 | 20/2, p. 503 | 1408 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4 | Zuchtordnung [1575] | 1575 | 20/2, p. 505 | 1408 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel 10. Mai 1578 | 1578 | 20/2, p. 509 | 1408 | Other | MR | |
| 6 | Eid der Mitglieder des Ehegerichts [nach 1581] | 1581 | 20/2, p. 511 | 1408 | Consistory / synod / government | MR | |
| 7 | Mandat zu den Kreuzgängen 4. Juni 1588 | 1588 | 20/2, p. 512 | 1408 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 8a | Deklarationsschrift. Erläuterung zu den Artikeln 10 und 13 der Confessio Augustana [22. Dezember 1589] | 1589 | 20/2, p. 513 | 1408 | Confession / doctrine | MR | |
| 8b | Gutachten der Weißenburger Prädikanten zur Colmarer Deklarationsschrift 25. Juli 1590 | 1590 | 20/2, p. 519 | 1408 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 9 | Eid der Prediger [3. Februar 1590] | 1590 | 20/2, p. 523 | 1408 | Appointment / oath | MR | |
| 10 | Eheordnung [vor 1593] | 1593 | 20/2, p. 525 | 1408 | Marriage | MR | |
| 11 | Mandat gegen Gotteslästerung [vor 1593] | 1593 | 20/2, p. 528 | 1408 | Mandate / decree | MR | |
| 12 | Hochzeitsmandat 11. April 1601 | 1601 | 20/2, p. 529 | 1408 | Marriage | MR | |
| 13 | Gottesdienstordnung [zwischen 11. Januar 1601 und 6. Oktober 1603] | 1603 | 20/2, p. 530 | 1408 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 14 | Hochzeitsmandat 3. Dezember 1608 | 1608 | 20/2, p. 532 | 1408 | Marriage | MR | |
| 15 | Eid der Prediger [25. April 1615] | 1615 | 20/2, p. 535 | 1408 | Appointment / oath | MR | |

## 1.32 Volume 21: North Rhine-Westphalia I: Jülich-Cleves-Berg, Lippe and others

52 texts.

### 1.32.1 United Duchies of Jülich-Cleves-Berg

- **Tradition**: Roman Catholic humanist (Erasmian).
- **Note**: An Erasmian Catholic reform (orders of 1532/1533), not a Protestant church order.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Kirchenordnung 1532/ | 1532 | 21, p. 33 | 1420 | Church order | RCH | |
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1525 | 1525 | 21, p. 49 | 1421 | Church order | RCH | |
| 2a | Kirchenordnung 1532 | 1532 | 21, p. 52 | 1421 | Church order | RCH | |
| 2b | Kirchenordnung 1532/: Visitationsinstruktion [1532] | 1532 | 21, p. 57 | 1421 | Visitation | RCH | |
| 2c | Kirchenordnung 1532/: Deklaration zur Kirchenordnung 1533 | 1533 | 21, p. 60 | 1421 | Church order | RCH | |
| 3a | Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1534 | 1534 | 21, p. 73 | 1421 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 3b | Täufermandate: Mandat gegen Täufer aus Münster 1535 | 1535 | 21, p. 75 | 1421 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 4 | Mandat gegen Prozessionen 1554 | 1554 | 21, p. 77 | 1422 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 5 | Armenordnung 1554 | 1554 | 21, p. 78 | 1423 | Poor relief | RCH | |
| 6 | Abendmahlsmandat [um 1558] | 1558 | 21, p. 81 | 1424 | Agenda / liturgy | RCH | |
| 7 | Visitationsinstruktion 1559 | 1559 | 21, p. 84 | 1425 | Visitation | RCH | |
| 8 | Mandat zum Lebenswandel der Geistlichen 1562 | 1562 | 21, p. 90 | 1426 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 9a | Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1565 | 1565 | 21, p. 91 | 1426 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 9b | Täufermandat: Ausführungsbefehl zum Täufermandat 1565 | 1565 | 21, p. 96 | 1426 | Discipline / police | RCH | |
| 10 | Mandat gegen fremde Prediger [1567] | 1567 | 21, p. 97 | 1427 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 11 | Mandat gegen eigenmächtige Neuerungen durch die Geistlichen 1567 | 1567 | 21, p. 99 | 1428 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 12 | Mandat zur ordentlichen Approbation der Geistlichen 1570 | 1570 | 21, p. 100 | 1429 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |
| 13 | Mandat zu kirchlichen Zeremonien 1572 | 1572 | 21, p. 101 | 1430 | Mandate / decree | RCH | |

#### 1.32.2 Bishopric and town of Minden

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Überschreibung des Dominikanerklosters St. Paul an den Rat 1530 | 1530 | 21, p. 119 | 1433 | Monastery / chapter | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Kirchenordnung 1530 | 1530 | 21, p. 121 | 1434 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Vertrag zwischen der Stadt Minden und dem Domkapitel 1535 | 1535 | 21, p. 146 | 1435 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 4 | Polizeiordnung 1566 | 1566 | 21, p. 149 | 1436 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5 | Lübbecker Rezess 1573 | 1573 | 21, p. 151 | 1437 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 6 | Festlegung des evangelischen Bekenntnisstands im Fürstbistum 1583 | 1583 | 21, p. 154 | 1438 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 7 | Polizeiordnung 1604 | 1604 | 21, p. 155 | 1439 | Discipline / police | L | |

#### 1.32.3 Imperial abbey and town of Herford

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1532 | 1532 | 21, p. 165 | 1442 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.32.4 Imperial city of Dortmund

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mandat zur Zulassung evangelischer Predigt 1532 | 1532 | 21, p. 207 | 1445 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Gottesdienstordnung 1554 | 1554 | 21, p. 208 | 1446 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3 | Mandat zur Freigabe des Abendmahls unter beiderlei Gestalt 1562 | 1562 | 21, p. 216 | 1447 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Mandat zur Zulassung deutscher Gottesdienste 1564 | 1564 | 21, p. 218 | 1448 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Mandat gegen Täufer und Anhänger anderer abweichender Lehren 1570 | 1570 | 21, p. 219 | 1449 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 6 | Armenordnung 1596 | 1596 | 21, p. 221 | 1450 | Poor relief | L | |

#### 1.32.5 Imperial abbey of Corvey (Höxter)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vertrag zwischen dem Petersstift und der Stadt Höxter 1533 | 1533 | 21, p. 235 | 1453 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 2 | Vertrag zwischen dem Petersstift und der Stadt Höxter 1536 | 1536 | 21, p. 237 | 1454 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen 1603 | 1603 | 21, p. 240 | 1455 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.32.6 County of Lippe

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1600.
- **Note**: Lutheran (1538) until Simon VI's 'Second Reformation' after 1600; Lemgo stayed Lutheran.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 11, Reformed 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Lemgoer Kirchenordnung 1537 | 1537 | 21, p. 301 | 1458 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Lippische Kirchenordnung 1538 | 1538 | 21, p. 306 | 1459 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung des Antonius Corvinus [1542] | 1542 | 21, p. 344 | 1460 | Church order | L | |
| 4a | Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Zeremonienordnung [1542] | 1542 | 21, p. 351 | 1460 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4b | Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ordinationsordnung [1542] | 1542 | 21, p. 359 | 1460 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 4c | Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Zuchtordnung [1542] | 1542 | 21, p. 361 | 1460 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 4d | Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ausschreiben zur revidierten Kirchenordnung 1559 | 1559 | 21, p. 366 | 1460 | Church order | L | |
| 4e | Die Revision der Kirchenordnung von 1538: Ausschreiben zur revidierten Kirchenordnung 1564 | 1564 | 21, p. 368 | 1460 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Visitationsinstruktion 1566 | 1566 | 21, p. 371 | 1461 | Visitation | L | |
| 6 | Kirchenordnung 1571 | 1571 | 21, p. 373 | 1462 | Church order | L | |
| 7 | Visitations-, Konsistorial- und Ehegerichtsordnung 1600 | 1600 | 21, p. 462 | 1462 | Visitation | R | |
| 8 | Röhrentruper Rezess 1617 | 1617 | 21, p. 484 | 1462 | Treaty / agreement | L | guarantees Lemgo's Lutheran confession |

#### 1.32.7 Imperial abbey and town of Essen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Ratsbeschluss zum deutschen Psalmengesang in St. Gertrud 1561 | 1561 | 21, p. 497 | 1465 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Ratsmandat, Personen geistlichen Standes nicht zu beschimpfen [1563] | 1563 | 21, p. 498 | 1466 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Predigerartikel 1571 | 1571 | 21, p. 499 | 1467 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Mandat zu Winkelpredigten und Sonntagsheiligung 1573 | 1573 | 21, p. 503 | 1468 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 5 | Armenordnung 1581 | 1581 | 21, p. 504 | 1469 | Poor relief | L | |

## 1.33 Volume 22: North Rhine-Westphalia II: Cologne, Wittgenstein, Bentheim, Soest and others

65 texts.

### 1.33.1 Archbishopric of Cologne

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed; Reformed from 1583.
- **Note**: Hermann von Wied's Reformation attempt (1542-1547; Bucer and Melanchthon); Gebhard Truchsess's attempt (1583) was backed by the Reformed.
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 2, Moderate Reformed 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung 1546 | 1546 | 22, p. 41 | 1484 | Agenda / liturgy | MR | |
| 2 | Edikt zur evangelischen Religionsausübung 1583 | 1583 | 22, p. 47 | 1485 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 3 | Ausschreiben zur freien Religionsausübung 1583 | 1583 | 22, p. 50 | 1486 | Mandate / decree | R | |

### 1.33.2 County of Wittgenstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1574.
- **Note**: Reformed from about 1574.
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 11, Reformed 10.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1a | Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung 1546: Kirchenordnung 1555: Kirchenordnung | 1555 | 22, p. 79 | 1491 | Church order | L | |
| 1b | Kirchenordnung 1555: Mandate zur Einberufung der Synode | 1555 | 22, p. 94 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1c | Kirchenordnung 1555: Anweisungen für die Rentmeister | 1555 | 22, p. 95 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Kirchenordnung 1563 | 1563 | 22, p. 96 | 1493 | Church order | L | |
| 3 | Kirchenordnung [1565] | 1565 | 22, p. 107 | 1493 | Church order | L | |
| 4 | Mandat, die Kirchenordnung zu beachten 1569 | 1569 | 22, p. 119 | 1493 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Synodalbeschluss 1569 | 1569 | 22, p. 120 | 1493 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Hofordnung 1570 | 1570 | 22, p. 121 | 1493 | Other | L | |
| 7 | Polizeiordnung 1573 | 1573 | 22, p. 124 | 1493 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 8 | Eheordnung 1579 | 1579 | 22, p. 127 | 1493 | Marriage | R | |
| 9a | Mandate zu Pfarrgütern und Gottesdiensten 1584: Mandat, die Pfarrgüter zu schützen | 1584 | 22, p. 131 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 9b | Mandat zu Gottesdiensten, Katechismusunterricht und Pfarrgütern | 1584 | 22, p. 133 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 10 | Synodalprotokoll 1585 | 1585 | 22, p. 134 | 1493 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 11 | Gerichts- und Polizeiordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg 1562/1563 | 1563 | 22, p. 135 | 1493 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Hochzeits- und Taufordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg 1570 | 1570 | 22, p. 137 | 1493 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 13 | Kirchenzuchtordnung für die Herrschaft Homburg [1605] | 1605 | 22, p. 139 | 1493 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 14 | Mandat zur Einführung des reformierten Bekenntnisses in der Herrschaft Homburg 1605 | 1605 | 22, p. 145 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 15 | Mandat zur Anstellung des Predigers Albert Schnabel in Marienhagen 1605 | 1605 | 22, p. 146 | 1493 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 16 | Beschlüsse zu Homburger Kirchensachen [1605] | 1605 | 22, p. 147 | 1493 | Other | R | |
| 17 | Mandat zu kirchlichen Belangen in der Herrschaft Homburg 1606 | 1606 | 22, p. 150 | 1494 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 18 | Täufermandat für die Herrschaft Homburg 1611 | 1611 | 22, p. 152 | 1494 | Discipline / police | R | |

#### 1.33.3 County of Moers

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1578.

- **Note**: Reformed under Count Adolf (1578-1589).
- **Texts by tradition**: Lutheran 3, Reformed 3.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Mandat zur Anstellung eines evangelischen Predigers in Krefeld 1561 | 1561 | 22, p. 169 | 1497 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Mandat zur Besetzung der Pfarrstelle in Krefeld 1565 | 1565 | 22, p. 170 | 1498 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Mandat zur Umwandlung des Karmeliterklosters in eine Schule [1573] | 1573 | 22, p. 171 | 1499 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Polizeiordnung 1574/1580/1581 | 1581 | 22, p. 173 | 1500 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung [1581] | 1581 | 22, p. 179 | 1502 | Church order | R | |
| 6 | Kanzelabkündigung zur Kirchenordnung 1603 | 1603 | 22, p. 216 | 1502 | Church order | R | |

#### 1.33.4 County of Bentheim-Tecklenburg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran; Reformed from 1586.
- **Note**: Reformed from the 1580s (order of 1588).
- **Texts by tradition**: Reformed 10, Lutheran 2.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung 1543 | 1543 | 22, p. 241 | 1505 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Ordnung für das Tecklenburger Zisterzienserinnenkloster Leeden 1585 | 1585 | 22, p. 247 | 1506 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 3 | Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung 1588/1619 | 1619 | 22, p. 249 | 1507 | Church order | R | |
| 4 | Tecklenburger Polizeiordnung 1601/1612 | 1612 | 22, p. 298 | 1508 | Discipline / police | R | |
| 5 | Mandat zum Glockenläuten bei Gottesdiensten und Begräbnissen 1601 | 1601 | 22, p. 302 | 1508 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 6 | Mandat zu Klassikalkonventen, Generalsynoden und Kirchenorganisation 1604 | 1604 | 22, p. 304 | 1508 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 7 | Einrichtung des Steinfurter Ehegerichts 1606 | 1606 | 22, p. 306 | 1508 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |
| 8a | Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bentheimer Glaubensartikel [1613] | 1613 | 22, p. 308 | 1508 | Confession / doctrine | R | |
| 8b | Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bestätigung des Heidelberger Katechismus 1617 | 1617 | 22, p. 311 | 1508 | Catechism / instruction | R | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 8c | Die Bentheimer Artikel: Bestätigung der Glaubensartikel 1619 | 1619 | 22, p. 313 | 1508 | Confession / doctrine | R | |
| 9 | Mandat zur Einsetzung des Oberkirchenrats in der Grafschaft Bentheim 1613 | 1613 | 22, p. 314 | 1508 | Mandate / decree | R | |
| 10 | Einrichtung des Kirchenrats in Rheda 1619 | 1619 | 22, p. 316 | 1508 | Consistory / synod / government | R | |

#### 1.33.5 County of Rietberg

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Polizeiordnung 1566 | 1566 | 22, p. 329 | 1513 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 2 | Anstellungsurkunde für den Rietberger Pfarrer Simon Hagemann 1568 | 1568 | 22, p. 332 | 1514 | Appointment / oath | L | |

#### 1.33.6 City of Münster

- **Tradition**: Moderate Reformed.
- **Note**: Bernhard Rothmann's evangelical order moved from Lutheran to Zwinglian views before the Anabaptist kingdom of 1534/35.
- **Texts by tradition**: Moderate Reformed 4, Anabaptist (toleration) 1, Roman Catholic 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Vereinbarung von Rat und Gemeinde über Anstellung evangelischer Prediger an den Stadtkirchen 1532 | 1532 | 22, p. 347 | 1518 | Appointment / oath | MR | |
| 2 | Vertrag von Bischof und Stadt zur Reformation 1533 | 1533 | 22, p. 349 | 1519 | Treaty / agreement | MR | |
| 3 | Zuchtordnung 1533 | 1533 | 22, p. 354 | 1520 | Discipline / police | MR | |
| 4 | Summarium der Kirchenordnung [1533] | 1533 | 22, p. 361 | 1521 | Church order | MR | |
| 5 | Mandat zur Duldung der Täufer 1534 | 1534 | 22, p. 363 | 1522 | Mandate / decree | ANA | the council and guilds let each keep his faith, recognizing the Anabaptists (31 January 1534) |
| 6 | Bischöfliches Edikt gegen die Täufer 1534 | 1534 | 22, p. 364 | 1523 | Discipline / police | RC | Bishop Franz von Waldeck's edict |

#### 1.33.7 City of Soest

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.
- **Interim**: 1 text(s) tied to the Augsburg Interim (see the last column).

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1532 | 1532 | 22, p. 385 | 1527 | Church order | L | |
| 2 | Mandat zur Residenzpflicht der Pfarrer und zur evangelischen Predigt 1532 | 1532 | 22, p. 460 | 1528 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Die „Lätareartikel" 1533 | 1533 | 22, p. 462 | 1529 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Ordnung für das Kloster St. Walburgis 1543 | 1543 | 22, p. 465 | 1530 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 5 | Mandat zum Abendmahl unter beiderlei Gestalt 1552 | 1552 | 22, p. 472 | 1531 | Mandate / decree | L | **After the Interim** |
| 6 | Anstellungsartikel für die Prediger 1554 | 1554 | 22, p. 474 | 1532 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7 | Armenordnung 1581 | 1581 | 22, p. 475 | 1533 | Poor relief | L | |
| 8 | Anweisung zu den Taufpaten 1583 | 1583 | 22, p. 478 | 1534 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 9 | Eheordnung 1583 | 1583 | 22, p. 479 | 1535 | Marriage | L | |
| 10 | Artikel der Prediger 1590 | 1590 | 22, p. 480 | 1536 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 11 | Armenordnung 1597 | 1597 | 22, p. 482 | 1537 | Poor relief | L | |
| 12 | Kirchenordnung [1609] | 1609 | 22, p. 484 | 1538 | Church order | L | |
| 13 | Kirchenordnung für die Soester Börde 1609/1619 | 1619 | 22, p. 498 | 1539 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.33.8 Town of Neuenrade

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Kirchenordnung 1564 | 1564 | 22, p. 515 | 1544 | Church order | L | |

#### 1.33.9 County of Lippe (supplement)

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Deutsche Messe [ca. 1525-1538] | 1538 | 22, p. 565 | 1549 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

### 1.34 Volume 23: Schleswig-Holstein and Dithmarschen

88 texts.

### 1.34.1 Duchies of Schleswig and Holstein

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Deutsche Messe [nach 1526] | 1526 | 23, p. 55 | 1576 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Bestätigung des zwischen der Gemeinde und den Geistlichen von Husum geschlossenen Vertrags durch König Friedrich I. 17. November 1527 | 1527 | 23, p. 60 | 1576 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 3 | Hadersiebener Artikel [1528] | 1528 | 23, p. 62 | 1576 | Other | L | |
| 4 | Anweisung zur Verwendung von Geldern des Hadersiebener Domes für den Unterhalt der Kirchen- und Schuldiener sowie für die Versorgung der Armen 25. … | 1533 | 23, p. 69 | 1576 | School / university | L | |
| 5 | Verordnung über Superintendenten und Geistliche in den Ämtern Flensburg und Tondern April 1540 | 1540 | 23, p. 72 | 1576 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 6 | Anweisung für die Visitatoren der Klöster 6. Januar 1541 | 1541 | 23, p. 76 | 1576 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Kirchenordnung 1542 | 1542 | 23, p. 80 | 1576 | Church order | L | |
| 8 | Schulordnung 25. Mai 1544 | 1544 | 23, p. 151 | 1576 | School / university | L | |
| 9 | Eheordnung 24. Juni 1544 | 1544 | 23, p. 155 | 1576 | Marriage | L | |
| 1 | Mandat gegen Täufer und Sakramentierer 1. August 1555 | 1555 | 23, p. 171 | 1580 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Mandat gegen Täufer 15. März 1562 | 1562 | 23, p. 173 | 1581 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Anordnung zum Vollzug des Abschieds des Lüneburger Kreistages 21. Juni 1562 | 1562 | 23, p. 175 | 1582 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 4 | Einrichtung eines Almosenkastens in den Kirchen zur Versorgung der Versehrten der Türkenkriege 1. Oktober 1595 | 1595 | 23, p. 179 | 1583 | Poor relief | L | |
| 5 | Klosterordnung für die noch bestehenden Frauenkonvente [nach 1610] | 1610 | 23, p. 181 | 1584 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 1 | Zuchtordnung für die Ämter Hadersleben und Törning 15. Mai 1550 | 1550 | 23, p. 207 | 1586 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 2 | Anweisung an den Adel zur Einhaltung der Sonn- und Feiertage durch deren Untertanen März 1551 | 1551 | 23, p. 210 | 1587 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 3 | Mandat für die Landschaft Nordstrand zur Berufung und Absetzung von Geistlichen Februar 1553 | 1553 | 23, p. 211 | 1588 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Anweisung zur Abhaltung von Bettagen 3. März 1553 | 1553 | 23, p. 213 | 1589 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 5 | Kirchenordnung für die Landschaft Nordstrand [22. Juli 1556] | 1556 | 23, p. 215 | 1590 | Church order | L | |
| 6 | Mandat zum Unterhalt der Geistlichen und der Kirchen und zum Umgang mit dem Kirchenland im Amt Tondern 25. Juli 1556 | 1556 | 23, p. 221 | 1591 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 7 | Mandat zur Entrichtung des Zehnten für die Propstei Hadersleben 6. August 1561 | 1561 | 23, p. 223 | 1592 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Einsetzung von Disziplinaraufsehern in den Pfarreien der Ämter Hadersleben und Törning Juni 1564 | 1564 | 23, p. 225 | 1593 | Other | L | |
| 9a | Anweisung für das zukünftige Verhalten der Mönche im Kloster Bordesholm 31. Mai 1565 | 1565 | 23, p. 227 | 1594 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 9b | Reformation des Klosters Bordesholm 16. März 1566 | 1566 | 23, p. 228 | 1594 | Church order | L | |
| 10 | Mandat für die Propstei Hadersleben zu Kirchenregistern und Kirchenrechnung 4. April 1568 | 1568 | 23, p. 232 | 1595 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Erstattung von Aufwendungen für die Pfarrhäuser durch die Amtsnachfolger 2. September 1569 | 1569 | 23, p. 234 | 1596 | Other | L | |
| 12 | Verordnung zum Kirchen- und Armenwesen in Rendsburg 20. September 1571 | 1571 | 23, p. 236 | 1597 | Poor relief | L | |
| 13 | Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen in Hadersleben 31. Mai 1571 | 1571 | 23, p. 242 | 1598 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14 | Zuchtordnung für das Amt Rendsburg und die Angehörigen des Klosters Bordesholm Februar 1573 | 1573 | 23, p. 243 | 1599 | Monastery / chapter | L | |
| 1 | Mandat für die Kremper und Wilster Marsch wegen der Entrichtung der Abgaben zur Versorgung der Geistlichen und Lehrer 23. März 1547 | 1547 | 23, p. 265 | 1600 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 2 | Anweisung an die Geistlichen der Kremper und Wilster Marsch zum Gehorsam gegenüber dem Propst 23. März 1547 | 1547 | 23, p. 267 | 1601 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3a | Anweisung zur Abhaltung von drei Bettagen 28. Februar 1553 | 1553 | 23, p. 269 | 1602 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 3b | Mandat zur Durchführung von drei Bettagen 21. Dezember 1557 | 1557 | 23, p. 271 | 1603 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Anweisung für die Pfarrer des Herzogtums Holstein wegen der Täufer und anderer Sektierer November 1553 | 1553 | 23, p. 273 | 1604 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 5a | Vergleich zum Gnadenjahr der Pfarrwitwen des Münsterdorfer Kalands [1559] | 1559 | 23, p. 275 | 1605 | Poor relief | L | |
| 5b | Entscheidung zur Ausgestaltung des Gnadenjahres der Pfarrwitwen des Segeberger Kalands Juni 1596 | 1596 | 23, p. 276 | 1605 | Poor relief | L | |
| 6 | Kirchenordnung von Heiligenstedten 1564 | 1564 | 23, p. 278 | 1606 | Church order | L | |
| 7 | Bestimmungen des Münsterdorfer Konsistoriums zur Eheschließung 13. Januar 1565 | 1565 | 23, p. 280 | 1607 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 8 | Mandat wegen der Entrichtung des Zehnten und anderer Abgaben im Amt Flensburg August 1574 | 1574 | 23, p. 282 | 1608 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 9 | Statuten des Münsterdorfer Kalands 1574 | 1574 | 23, p. 284 | 1609 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 10 | Befehl an den Statthalter Heinrich Rantzau wegen der Bettage 24. Januar 1581 | 1581 | 23, p. 287 | 1611 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 11 | Zuchtordnung für das Amt Flensburg 24. November 1605 | 1605 | 23, p. 288 | 1611 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 12 | Mandat zur Bestrafung der Personen, die nicht am Abendmahl teilnehmen 21. Juli 1614 | 1614 | 23, p. 292 | 1612 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 1 | Vertrag zwischen Herzog Adolf I. und dem Domkapitel in Schleswig wegen der Wahl des Herzogs zum Administrator des Bistums Schleswig 31. Juli 1556 | 1556 | 23, p. 327 | 1613 | Treaty / agreement | L | |
| 2 | Mandat für die Visitatoren 2. August 1557 | 1557 | 23, p. 333 | 1615 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 3 | Bekenntnis der Geistlichen der Landschaft Eiderstedt [3. August] 1557 | 1557 | 23, p. 335 | 1616 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 4a | Bestallung Pauls von Eitzen zum Rat und Diener von Haus aus 10. Juni 1561 | 1561 | 23, p. 339 | 1617 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 4b | Eid des Schleswiger Superintendenten Paul von Eitzen 1562 | 1562 | 23, p. 340 | 1617 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 5 | Katechismus des Paul von Eitzen 1571 | 1571 | 23, p. 341 | 1618 | Catechism / instruction | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | Eid der Gottorfer Prediger [vor 15. September 1574] | 1574 | 23, p. 364 | 1618 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 7 | Ordinationsbescheinigungen 22. März 1583 / 7. April 1611 | 1611 | 23, p. 366 | 1619 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 8a | Anweisung für die Visitatoren zur Durchführung einer Generalvisitation und zur Einsetzung von Pröpsten 21. Februar 1587 | 1587 | 23, p. 368 | 1619 | Visitation | L | |
| 8b | Mandat wegen der Entrichtung des Zehnten und anderer Abgaben im Amt Flensburg August 1574: Visitationsartikel 1587 | 1587 | 23, p. 371 | 1621 | Visitation | L | |
| 9 | Berufung von Johannes Pistorius zum Hofprediger 8. Oktober 1588 | 1588 | 23, p. 374 | 1621 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 10 | Beauftragung des Propstes Jakob Fabricius mit der Examination und der Ordination der Kirchendiener sowie der jährlichen Visitation von Nordstrand 28. … | 1593 | 23, p. 376 | 1622 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 11 | Kirchenordnung für das Amt Apenrade 1. Januar 1598 | 1598 | 23, p. 378 | 1623 | Church order | L | |
| 12 | Mandat für die Ämter Trittau und Reinbek über Beichte, Verhalten während des Gottesdienstes sowie Trauung und Taufe fremder Personen 16. Juli 1600 | 1600 | 23, p. 385 | 1625 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 13 | Befehl an den Propst von Eiderstedt, eine Person ohne vorhergehende öffentliche Kirchenbuße wieder zum Abendmahl zuzulassen 31. Mai 1602 | 1602 | 23, p. 387 | 1626 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 14 | Katechismus von Jakob Fabricius d.Ä. 1. Dezember 1602 | 1602 | 23, p. 388 | 1626 | Catechism / instruction | L | |
| 15 | Zuchtordnung für die Landschaft Nordstrand 10. Februar 1605 | 1605 | 23, p. 409 | 1628 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 16a | Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides 4. Januar 1607 | 1607 | 23, p. 415 | 1628 | Other | L | |
| 16b | Neuer Predigereid [4. Januar 1607] | 1607 | 23, p. 416 | 1628 | Other | L | |
| 17 | Revision der Bestallung von Jakob Fabricius zum Generalpropst [4. April 1608] | 1608 | 23, p. 417 | 1628 | Appointment / oath | L | |
| 18 | Verfügung gegen die Anhänger des David Joris und andere Täufer in der Landschaft Eiderstedt 10. November 1608 | 1608 | 23, p. 420 | 1628 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 19 | Predigtmandat 11. April 1609 | 1609 | 23, p. 423 | 1628 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 20 | Verbot der Abkündigung weltlicher Sachen durch die Pfarrer 16. August 1610 | 1610 | 23, p. 425 | 1628 | Mandate / decree | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 21 | Mandat gegen die Mennoniten und andere Täufer in Eiderstedt 1. Dezember 1614 | 1614 | 23, p. 426 | 1628 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 22 | Verordnung zur Predigt und zum Umgang mit umstrittenen Glaubensartikeln 26. Februar 1617 | 1617 | 23, p. 429 | 1628 | Confession / doctrine | L | |

#### 1.34.2 Land of Dithmarschen

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Abendmahlsordnung [1532] | 1532 | 23, p. 449 | 1639 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 1 | Abendmahlsordnung [1532] | 1532 | 23, p. 449 | 1639 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |
| 2 | Das „erste Edikt“ - Kirchenzuchtmandat 14. Juli 1537 | 1537 | 23, p. 455 | 1639 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 3 | Mandat zum Gnadenjahr für die Pfarrwitwen 20. Dezember 1539 | 1539 | 23, p. 457 | 1639 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 4 | Landesabschied zu Ehesachen [1539] | 1539 | 23, p. 458 | 1639 | Marriage | L | |
| 5 | Das „zweite Edikt“ - Kirchenzuchtmandat 20. März 1540 | 1540 | 23, p. 460 | 1639 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 6 | Fundationsbrief zur Einrichtung einer Schule im Kloster Meldorf 19. Juni 1540 | 1540 | 23, p. 464 | 1639 | School / university | L | |
| 7 | Landesbeschluß für Prediger und Gemeinden 25. Juni 1541 | 1541 | 23, p. 467 | 1639 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 8 | Beschluß zu Eheeinsegnung, Kirchengütern und anderen kirchlichen Belangen 19. Mai 1543 | 1543 | 23, p. 468 | 1639 | Marriage | L | |
| 9 | Beschlüsse des Meldorf er Kalands 19. April 1547 | 1547 | 23, p. 470 | 1639 | Other | L | |
| 10 | Bekenntnis der Dithmarscher Kirche zum lutherischen Abendmahl [nach 23. Juni] 1556 | 1556 | 23, p. 473 | 1639 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
|  | IIa. Resolution des Rendsburger Rechtstags 3. Oktober 1559 | 1559 | 23, p. 477 | 1639 | Mandate / decree | L | |
|  | IIb. Religionsinstruktion 10. November 1559 | 1559 | 23, p. 478 | 1639 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 12 | Dithmarscher Landrecht 2. November 1567 | 1567 | 23, p. 481 | 1639 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 13a | Visitationsartikel für den Süderdrittenteil 1574/75 | 1574 | 23, p. 484 | 1639 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13b | Visitationsmandat für den Norderdrittenteil 28. Februar 1575 | 1575 | 23, p. 491 | 1639 | Visitation | L | |
| 14 | Polizeiordnung für den Norderdrittenteil [um 1579] | 1579 | 23, p. 492 | 1639 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 15 | Mandat für den Superintendenten in Norderdithmarschen 12. Juli 1597 | 1597 | 23, p. 505 | 1639 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 16 | Mandat zur Superintendenten- und Pfarrerwahl in Norderdithmarschen 5. Juli 1605 | 1605 | 23, p. 507 | 1640 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 17 | Mandat über die Pflichten der Superintendenten in Norderdithmarschen 18. Februar 1606 | 1606 | 23, p. 510 | 1641 | Mandate / decree | L | |

## 1.35 Volume 24: Transylvania

121 texts.

### 1.35.1 Principality of Transylvania: diets

- **Tradition**: Multi-confessional diet.
- **Note**: Diet decrees for a principality with several received confessions (Lutheran, Reformed, Unitarian, Catholic).
- **Texts by tradition**: Multi-confessional diet 25, Lutheran 1.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1552 | 1552 | 24, p. 45 | 1652 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 2 | Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1556 | 1556 | 24, p. 47 | 1653 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 3 | Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1557 | 1557 | 24, p. 50 | 1654 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 4 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1557 | 1557 | 24, p. 52 | 1654 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 5 | Consensus Doctrinae 1557 | 1557 | 24, p. 56 | 1656 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 6 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1558 | 1558 | 24, p. 67 | 1657 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 7 | Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1558 | 1558 | 24, p. 70 | 1657 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 8 | Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1560 | 1560 | 24, p. 72 | 1659 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 9 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1563 | 1563 | 24, p. 74 | 1660 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 10 | Schäßburger Landtagsabschied 1564 | 1564 | 24, p. 76 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 11 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1564 | 1564 | 24, p. 78 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 12 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1566 | 1566 | 24, p. 80 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 13 | Hermannstädter Landtagsabschied 1566 | 1566 | 24, p. 82 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1568 | 1568 | 24, p. 84 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 15 | Neumarkter Landtagsabschied 1571 | 1571 | 24, p. 86 | 1661 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 16 | Landesherrliches Druckverbot 1571 | 1571 | 24, p. 88 | 1661 | Discipline / police | T | |
| 17 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 89 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 18 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 91 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 19 | Mediascher Landtagsabschied 1576 | 1576 | 24, p. 93 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 20 | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 94 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 21 | Klausenburger Landtagsabschied 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 95 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 22 | Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1590 | 1590 | 24, p. 96 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 23 | Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1595 | 1595 | 24, p. 98 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 24 | Léczfalvaer Landtagsabschied 1600 | 1600 | 24, p. 100 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 25 | Mediascher Landtagsabschied 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 102 | 1662 | Treaty / agreement | T | |
| 26 | Weißenburger Landtagsabschied 1619 | 1619 | 24, p. 104 | 1663 | Treaty / agreement | T | |

#### 1.35.2 Transylvanian Saxons

- **Tradition**: Lutheran.

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1a | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1552: Reformationsbüchlein 1543 | 1543 | 24, p. 177 | 1666 | Other | L | |
| 1b | Reformationsbüchlein 1543 (deutsche Fassung) | 1543 | 24, p. 191 | 1666 | Other | L | |
| 2 | Universitätsbeschluss 1544 | 1544 | 24, p. 203 | 1667 | School / university | L | |
| 3 | Universitätsbeschluss 1545 | 1545 | 24, p. 204 | 1668 | School / university | L | |
| 4a | Kirchenordnung 1547 (lateinische Fassung) | 1547 | 24, p. 206 | 1668 | Church order | L | |
| 4b | Thorenburger Landtagsabschied 1557: Kirchenordnung 1547 (deutsche Fassung) | 1547 | 24, p. 226 | 1669 | Church order | L | |
| 5 | Kronstädter Agende 1547 | 1547 | 24, p. 247 | 1670 | Agenda / liturgy | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 6 | Kirchenvisitation im Burzenländer Kapitel 1550 | 1550 | 24, p. 256 | 1671 | Visitation | L | |
| 7 | Universitätsbeschluss 1550 | 1550 | 24, p. 258 | 1672 | School / university | L | |
| 8 | Burzenländer Artikel 1556 | 1556 | 24, p. 259 | 1673 | Other | L | |
| 9 | Universitätsbeschlüsse 1557 | 1557 | 24, p. 260 | 1674 | School / university | L | |
| 10 | Hermannstädter Synodalbeschlüsse 1557 | 1557 | 24, p. 261 | 1675 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 11 | Bestätigung des Superintendenten 1558 | 1558 | 24, p. 264 | 1676 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 12 | Bestätigung der Zuständigkeiten der Geistlichkeit 1559 | 1559 | 24, p. 265 | 1677 | Other | L | |
| 13a | Zwölf gemeinsame Artikel der Nationsuniversität 1559 (deutsche Fassung) | 1559 | 24, p. 267 | 1677 | School / university | L | |
| 13b | Zwölf gemeinsame Artikel der Nationsuniversität 1560 (lateinische Fassung) | 1560 | 24, p. 269 | 1677 | School / university | L | |
| 14 | Anweisungen des Bistritzer Dechanten 1560 | 1560 | 24, p. 272 | 1678 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 15 | Vierzehn Artikel auf der gemeinsamen Mediascher Synode 1561 | 1561 | 24, p. 274 | 1679 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 16 | Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1562 | 1562 | 24, p. 280 | 1680 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 17 | Mandat zur Beibehaltung Wittenberger „doctrinam et ritum“ 1563 | 1563 | 24, p. 283 | 1681 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 18 | Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1563 | 1563 | 24, p. 284 | 1682 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 19a | Disziplinarordnung des Unterwälder Kapitels - Leges Ministrorum 1564 | 1564 | 24, p. 287 | 1682 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 19b | Disziplinarordnung des Unterwälder Kapitels - Ergänzungen 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 289 | 1682 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 20 | Hermannstädter Synodalartikel 1565 | 1565 | 24, p. 290 | 1683 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 21 | Disziplinarartikel für Schullehrer 1565 | 1565 | 24, p. 298 | 1684 | School / university | L | |
| 22 | Statuten des Bogeschdorfer Kapitels 1566 | 1566 | 24, p. 300 | 1685 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 23 | Visitationsordnung des Burzenländer Kapitels 1567 | 1567 | 24, p. 303 | 1686 | Visitation | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 24 | Gemeinsame Visitationsartikel 1569 | 1569 | 24, p. 306 | 1687 | Visitation | L | |
| 25 | Spezialartikel des Kapitels von Bulkesch 1569 | 1569 | 24, p. 310 | 1688 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 26 | Schutzbrief 1571 | 1571 | 24, p. 311 | 1689 | Other | L | |
| 27 | Statuten des Burzenländer Kapitels 1571 | 1571 | 24, p. 313 | 1690 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 28 | Universitätsbeschluss 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 319 | 1691 | School / university | L | |
| 29 | Landesherrliche Artikel zur Mediascher Synode (Articuli Dionysiani) 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 320 | 1691 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 30 | Eidformel der Geistlichen 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 323 | 1691 | Other | L | |
| 31 | Mandat zur Designation für das Superintendentenamt 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 325 | 1691 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 32 | Burzenländer Zucht-, Ehe- und Erbordnung | n.d. | 24, p. 326 | 1691 | Marriage | L | |
| 33 | Artikel der Mediascher Synode zu Amtspflichten und Lebenswandel der Pfarrer 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 329 | 1691 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 34 | Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode (Formula pii consensus) 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 331 | 1691 | Confession / doctrine | L | |
| 35 | Mandat zur Confessio Augustana 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 357 | 1691 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 36 | Bestätigung und Aufgabenbeschreibung des Superintendenten 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 359 | 1692 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 37a | Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Dechantenordnung 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 361 | 1692 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 37b | Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Statuten für Pfarrer, Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer 1572 | 1572 | 24, p. 365 | 1692 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 37c | Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Statuten der Lehrer 1606 | 1606 | 24, p. 367 | 1692 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 37d | Statuten des Lasselner Kapitels - Ergänzungen für Lehrer und Niedergeistliche 1606 | 1606 | 24, p. 369 | 1693 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 38 | Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 370 | 1693 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 39 | Statuten des Kisder Kapitels 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 372 | 1695 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 40 | Mandat über Ordination, ... 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 378 | 1696 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 41 | Mandat zur Nichtabsetzbarkeit sächs. Pfarrer 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 379 | 1697 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 42 | Visitationsartikel des Zwischenkokelgebietes 1573 | 1573 | 24, p. 381 | 1698 | Visitation | L | |
| 43 | Disziplinarartikel der Hermannstadter Synode 1574 | 1574 | 24, p. 382 | 1699 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 44 | Mandat gegen Ehen in verbotenen Graden 1575 | 1575 | 24, p. 385 | 1700 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 45 | Synodalbeschlüsse zur Kirchendisziplin 1575 | 1575 | 24, p. 386 | 1701 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 46 | Mandat zur Zuständigkeit in Ehesachen 1575 | 1575 | 24, p. 388 | 1702 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 47 | Ordnung für Niedergeistliche und Schullehrer im Kosder Kapitel 1575 | 1575 | 24, p. 389 | 1703 | School / university | L | |
| 48a | Bulkescher Kapitel - bestätigte alte Artikel 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 391 | 1703 | Other | L | |
| 48b | Bulkescher Kapitel - Kapitelstatuten 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 392 | 1703 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 48c | Bulkescher Kapitel Nachtrag 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 395 | 1703 | Other | L | |
| 48d | Bulkescher Kapitel - Ordnung der Schullehrer 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 397 | 1703 | School / university | L | |
| 49 | Statuten der Surrogatieverbände von Kosd und Schelken 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 399 | 1704 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 50 | Gemeinsame Artikel der Generalkirchenvisitation 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 404 | 1705 | Visitation | L | |
| 51 | Visitationsordnung des Bulkescher Kapitels 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 412 | 1706 | Visitation | L | |
| 52a | Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Mahnung zur christlichen Kirchenzucht 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 417 | 1706 | Visitation | L | |
| 52b | Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Visitationsordnung 1577 | 1577 | 24, p. 421 | 1706 | Visitation | L | |
| 52c | Kirchenvisitation im Bistritzer Kapitel - Einleitung der Visitationsartikel 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 424 | 1706 | Visitation | L | |
| 53 | Artikel der Mediascher Synode 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 426 | 1707 | Articles / statutes | L | |
| 54 | Statuten der Kapitel Tekendorf und Groß-Schogen 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 429 | 1708 | Discipline / police | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 55 | Gemeinsame Ordnung für Geistliche und Gemeinde 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 434 | 1709 | Other | L | |
| 56 | Burzenländer Visitationsartikel 1578 | 1578 | 24, p. 441 | 1710 | Visitation | L | |
| 57 | Gemeindestatuten des Burzenländer Kapitels 1580 | 1580 | 24, p. 453 | 1711 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 58a | Scholtener Kapitel - allgemeine Kapitelstatuten 1582 | 1582 | 24, p. 456 | 1711 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 58b | Scholtener Kapitel - Statuten der Lehrer 1582 | 1582 | 24, p. 460 | 1711 | School / university | L | |
| 59 | Ordnung der Präsentation von Pfarrern 1582 | 1582 | 24, p. 462 | 1712 | Local order | L | |
| 60 | Gemeinsame Landesordnung 1587 | 1587 | 24, p. 463 | 1713 | Discipline / police | L | |
| 61 | Protestation bei Einführung des gregorianischen Kalenders 1590 | 1590 | 24, p. 465 | 1714 | Other | L | |
| 62 | Mandat über Rechungslegung ... 1592 | 1592 | 24, p. 466 | 1715 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 63 | Schäßburger Synodalartikel 1593 | 1593 | 24, p. 468 | 1716 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 64 | Ordnung der Synoden 1593 | 1593 | 24, p. 469 | 1717 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 65 | Mandat über Zuständigkeit in Ehesachen 1593 | 1593 | 24, p. 470 | 1718 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 66 | Statuten des Hermannstädter Kapitels 1594 | 1594 | 24, p. 471 | 1719 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 67 | Ordnung der Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer im Hermannstadter Kapitel 1594 | 1594 | 24, p. 476 | 1720 | Local order | L | |
| 68 | Mediascher Synodalartikel gegen Zauberei 1595 | 1595 | 24, p. 478 | 1721 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 69 | Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl 1601 | 1601 | 24, p. 479 | 1722 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 70 | Ordnung der Niedergeistlichen und Lehrer im Schelker Kapitel 1603 | 1603 | 24, p. 481 | 1723 | Local order | L | |
| 71 | Mediascher Synodalartikel 1605 | 1605 | 24, p. 483 | 1724 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 72 | Mediascher Synodalartikel 1607 | 1607 | 24, p. 485 | 1725 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 73 | Articuli de ceremoniis 1607 | 1607 | 24, p. 488 | 1726 | Confession / doctrine | L | |

| No. | Order | Date | Sehling | Doc | Kind | Trad. | Interim / notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 74 | Synodale Ordnung für Niedergeistliche 1607 | 1607 | 24, p. 495 | 1727 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 75 | Gemeinsame Erweiterung der Artikel zur Generalkirchenvisitation 1607 | 1607 | 24, p. 497 | 1728 | Visitation | L | |
| 76 | Mediascher Synodalartikel 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 500 | 1729 | Consistory / synod / government | L | |
| 77 | Mandat zur Generalkirchenvisitation 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 507 | 1730 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 78 | Publikationsverbot 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 508 | 1731 | Other | L | |
| 79 | Mandat der Nationsuniversität 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 509 | 1732 | Mandate / decree | L | |
| 80 | Gemeinsame Ordnung der Pfarrerwahl 1615 | 1615 | 24, p. 511 | 1733 | Other | L | |
| 81 | Visitationsfragen des Hermannstädter Rates 1617 | 1617 | 24, p. 512 | 1734 | Visitation | L | |
| 82 | Eheordnung 1620 | 1620 | 24, p. 514 | 1735 | Marriage | L | |

# Chapter 2. The Order of the Mass

This chapter compares the **order of the Mass** (*ordo missae*, *Ordnung des Amts*, *Ordnung des Nachtmahls*) in the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. Other chapters of this book treat the parts of the Mass one by one. This chapter puts them back together. It asks:

- **The whole ordo.** What sequence of parts did each order prescribe, from the opening to the dismissal? Which orders kept the shape of the Roman Mass, and which built a new service around the sermon?
- **Families.** Which orders copied which? Where do the main types of evangelical Mass come from?
- **The ordinaries.** What happened to the fixed parts (the Kyrie, Gloria, Creed, Sanctus and Agnus Dei), and to the fixed dialogues and formulas around them (the salutation, the Preface dialogue, the Pax, the *Ite missa est*)? In particular:
  - Was the Kyrie sung three, four or nine times? Were the old seasonal Kyrie chants kept?
  - Who intoned the Gloria and the Creed? Which creed was sung?
  - Was the Sanctus sung with or without the Benedictus, and where did it fall?
  - How many times was the Agnus Dei sung, and how did it end?
  - What took the place of the *Ite missa est*?
- **The service without communicants.** What remained of the Mass when nobody came to the Lord's Table?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §2.1 summarizes the findings, and §2.2 sets out the scope, the method and what was not found.
- §2.3 sets the baselines: the Roman ordo, and Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) and *Deutsche Messe* (1526).
- §2.4 describes the families of evangelical ordo, and §2.5 compares them in a table.
- §§2.6–2.13 take the ordinaries and fixed formulas in order: Kyrie (§2.6), Gloria (§2.7), salutation, collect and Pax (§2.8), Creed (§2.9), Preface and Sanctus (§2.10), the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution (§2.11), Agnus Dei (§2.12), and the dismissal and blessing (§2.13).
- §2.14 deals with the Sunday service when nobody communicated.
- §2.15 gathers the ceremonial: the sign of the cross, kneeling, bowing, hats, hands, turning, places at the altar, the kiss of peace and incense.
- §2.16 is a concordance of the orders quoted.

**Related chapters.** This chapter refers to the others constantly. They hold the detail:

- the opening versicles, the confession and absolution, and the exhortation to communicants: Chapter 3;
- the introit, the lessons, the gradual, alleluia and sequence, the offertory, the Proper Prefaces and the communion chant: Chapter 4;
- the collect, the secret and the postcommunion: Chapter 5;
- the hymns sung in each slot, including the German, troped and paraphrased ordinaries ("Allein Gott", "Wir glauben all", "Jesaia dem Propheten", "Christe du Lamm Gottes"): Chapter 8, §§8.6–8.15;
- the canon, the Words of Institution and the elevation, order by order, in the early German Masses and their successors: Chapter 7;
- the sermon, its place and its length: Chapter 11;
- the general prayer of the church: Chapter 6;
- the Litany and the bidding prayers at the Mass: Chapter 13, §13.22;
- the organ in alternation with the choir: Chapter 9, §9.3;
- vestments, lights and the elevation as marks of the feast: Chapter 14 and Chapter 12, §12.10.

## 2.1 Summary of findings

**1. Two baselines, not one** (§2.3). Luther left two Masses, and the orders descend from both.

- **The *Formula missae* (1523)**: the Latin Mass with the offertory and canon cut and the Words of Institution sung in the Preface; the ordinaries kept "with various melodies for the various seasons"; *Benedicamus* for *Ite missa est*.
- **The *Deutsche Messe* (1526)**: German hymns for the introit and the chants; the Kyrie three times "and not nine"; no Gloria; a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and an exhortation for the Preface; the bread and cup given separately after their words.

**2. Seven families of ordo** (§2.4).

- **Saxon** (Wittenberg 1533, Saxony 1539, 1580): the Latin school Mass with German pieces grafted on; Preface only on feasts or not at all.
- **Bugenhagen's northern Mass** (Braunschweig 1528 to Mecklenburg 1552): Latin and German side by side; Preface, Sanctus and exhortation optional; "after the Amen nothing more is sung".
- **Franconian** (Nürnberg 1533, Hof 1592): no Preface; the epistle and gospel read as chapters in course; **the Sanctus after the Words of Institution**, then the Lord's Prayer and the Pax.
- **Prussian** (1525): the Words of Institution sung in the Preface; Kyrie in three tongues; Agnus Dei twice.
- **The Latin frame** (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, the Palatinate 1546, Breslau 1557): Preface dialogue, Pax and threefold Agnus kept; Breslau even kept *Ite missa est*.
- **Upper German** (Württemberg 1553, Strasbourg 1598, both Lutheran): the sermon service with the Supper added; no Kyrie, Gloria, Preface, Sanctus or Agnus.
- **Reformed** (Palatinate 1563, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, both Reformed): the Supper form read at the table, the Apostles' Creed, the breaking of bread.

**3. Kyrie: three, four or nine; never seven** (§2.6.1). Luther's "three times and not nine" became the parish norm. Nine survived for feasts and choirs (Wittenberg 1533; Pomerania 1542). A fourfold Kyrie (Kyrie, Christe, Kyrie, Kyrie) comes from Müntzer (1524, Radical Reformation) and survives in Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist). Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1543) allows "three times, four times or nine times" in figured music "at the schoolmaster's pleasure", but three plainly "in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost". No sevenfold Kyrie is found.

**4. The seasonal Kyrie chants survived** (§2.6.2). The orders with Latin schools kept the medieval cycle by name: *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *paschale*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *summum*, *minus summum*, *apostolicum*, *de martyribus*, *de virginibus* (Buxtehude 1526; Pomerania 1542; Nördlingen 1544; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Hof 1592, with the matching Gloria, Sanctus and Agnus "of the season").

**5. Gloria: the festal companion of the Kyrie** (§2.7). Not after "the plain Kyrie" (Wittenberg 1533); "at times and not always" (Pomerania 1535). Where kept, the priest intoned, the scholars sang *Et in terra* "and no more", the people sang "Allein Gott", and the scholars and organ finished the Latin (Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543).

**6. Creed: three layers, and two creeds** (§2.9). The priest intoned *Credo in unum Deum*, the scholars sang the Latin *Patrem*, and the people "Wir glauben all" (Wittenberg 1533 and most Saxon and northern orders). Prussia (1525) forbade the priest's intonation. Which creed (§2.9.4):

- **Nicene only**: the Saxon, Bugenhagen and Franconian orders, in Latin, in German verse by verse (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529), or as "Wir glauben".
- **Apostles' only**:
  - Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed), sung after the sermon, "the great *Patrem* … sung by some";
  - the Goslar foundation 1534;
  - the Upper German pulpit (Württemberg 1553);
    - the Reformed Supper (Frankfurt's French church 1554 and the Palatinate 1563, both Reformed).
- **A free choice**: Hesse 1574 (Philippist; the Apostles' Creed, Luther's paraphrase, or the Nicene); Kurland 1570.
- **By occasion**:
  - Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed): the Apostles' Creed every Sunday, the Nicene or Athanasian on the feasts of Christ;
  - Rothenberg 1618: "Wir glauben" on Sundays, the Apostles' Creed on other feasts;
  - Prussia 1568 and Feuchtwangen 1563: the Latin Nicene and the German creed on alternate Sundays.

**7. The Preface was optional; the Sanctus moved** (§2.10). The Preface was required in only a few orders, festal or optional in most, absent in the *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg, Albertine Saxony 1580 and Württemberg. The Sanctus stood in five places: before the Verba, after the Verba with or without a Preface, during the distribution, or nowhere. The Latin Sanctus kept its *Benedictus*; Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten" lost it; the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel Trinitarian Sanctus kept it with the Hebrew *Hosianna*.

**8. The Lord's Prayer and the Verba in seven sequences** (§2.11): the Lord's Prayer before the Verba, after them, paraphrased in the exhortation, sung as a hymn before the confession, or said inside a prayer before the creed. The bread and cup were given separately after their own words in the *Deutsche Messe*, Prussia 1544 and the Saxon villages.

**9. Agnus Dei: three, two or one** (§2.12). Three, as of old (Brandenburg 1540; Regensburg; Luther's German "Christe du Lamm Gottes" with "Gib uns deinen Frieden" the third time). **Two** in Prussia 1525 and Livonia 1533, "for brevity's sake", the first ending *miserere nobis* and the second *dona nobis pacem*. **Once** in the Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* (1545). It stood before, during or after the distribution.

**10. No *Ite missa est*; Benedicamus or nothing; Aaronic, Trinitarian or both** (§2.13).

- **The *Ite missa est***: kept only at Breslau (1557, beside the *Benedicamus*) and in the Ansbach visitation of 1536.
- **The *Benedicamus***, in its place:
    - in Latin, in the *Formula missae* and the Franconian, Pfalz-Neuburg, Regensburg, Hohenlohe, Henneberg and Transylvanian orders;
        - in German, in the early German Masses (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Lippe, Worms and Strasbourg (both Moderate Reformed)) and at Hof in 1592.
- **Neither**: the *Deutsche Messe* and most Saxon, Bugenhagen and Upper German orders end with the collect and the blessing.
- **The blessing**:
    - the Aaronic blessing is the rule;
        - Worms and Strasbourg (1524, both Moderate Reformed) and Regensburg (1542) used a Trinitarian blessing alone;
        - Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed) put both together;
    - Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533) offered four forms (Numbers 6, Psalm 67 and two Trinitarian), a set copied by a dozen orders;
    - Prussia (1525) sang Psalm 67 on feasts and the Aaronic blessing on ordinary days;
    - Strasbourg (1598) closed the sermon with the Trinitarian blessing and the Supper with both.

**11. Without communicants, no Mass** (§2.14). The service stopped after the sermon with a psalm, a collect and the blessing (Pomerania 1535; Mecklenburg 1552; Saxony 1580), or fell back to an office of psalm, chapter, creed and suffrages (Transylvania 1547). Hof kept a Mass-shaped daily service for its schoolboys, with the Kyrie, Sanctus and Agnus of the season and no communion.

**12. Few rubrics, and kneeling the chief gesture** (§2.15).

- **Sign of the cross.** It was still printed in the early German Masses: over bread and cup at Allstedt 1523 (Müntzer, Radical Reformation), and at the greeting and the blessing at Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed). Hof printed it at the Pax and the blessing in 1592. Elsewhere it was let go: "so many crosses" at Hannover 1536, and "without all papistical crossing" at Danzig 1557.
- **Kneeling, never genuflection.** No order knows the Roman genuflection. The priest kneels at the preparation and after communion. The people kneel at the Kyrie (Schwäbisch Hall 1527), at the Lord's Prayer before the Verba (Hall 1535) and at the thanksgiving. Communicants kneel at the altar. The Polish synods of the Sandomierz consensus (1578, 1583) allowed standing or kneeling but forbade sitting. Calvinizing Nassau (1575, Philippist) warned against "folded hands and bending of the knee" as to an idol.
- **Other gestures.**
    - Bows survive only in the Latin canons (Brandenburg 1540).
        - Men are bareheaded and women covered (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed).
    - Nothing is said of the celebrant's hands beyond what they hold.
    - The minister turns to the altar to pray and to the people to read, greet and exhort. Döber (1525) said everything toward the people.
- **Not found.** No epistle or gospel horn, no turn over the right shoulder, no *orans* or joined hands, no kiss of altar, book or deacon, no biretta rubric, no incense and no *Lavabo*. Strasbourg (1542, Moderate Reformed) replaced the kiss of peace with a reading on reconciliation.

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## 2.2 Scope, sources and method

### 2.2.1 Sources and searches

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`. Two searches were made:

- **Full ordos.** Every passage was found in which, within about 5,000 characters, the order names at least thirteen of the parts of the Mass (introit, Kyrie, Gloria, collect, epistle, gradual or sequence, gospel, creed, sermon, exhortation, Preface, Sanctus, Lord's Prayer, Words of Institution, Agnus Dei, distribution, thanksgiving, blessing). These passages, about forty in all, were read in full, and the representative ones are compared in §§2.4–2.5.
- **The ordinaries.** The corpus was searched for:
  - the Kyrie near the words for numbers (*drei*, *dreimal*, *neun*, *vier*, *sieben*, *ter*, *novies*, *semel*, *einmal*), and for runs of printed acclamations, which were counted;
  - the named Kyrie chants (*dominicale*, *angelicum*, *paschale*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *summum*, *apostolicum*, *de martyribus* and the rest);
  - the Agnus Dei near the same number words and near *dona nobis pacem*, *miserere nobis*, *gib uns deinen Frieden*;
  - *Benedictus qui venit*, *Osanna*, *Hosianna*;
  - *Ite missa est*, *Benedicamus*;
  - *symbolum apostolicum*, *Nicenum*, *Athanasii* near the Mass and its parts.

Pages were checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. One attribution was corrected in the course of the work: the Breslau account of the Sunday Mass and of the hours of the Passion is a report of 1557, not an order of 1550 (Sehling 3, pp. 404–405), and Chapter 10 has been amended accordingly.

### 2.2.2 What was not found

- **No sevenfold Kyrie.** The counts in the corpus are three, four and nine (§2.6.1). No order prescribes seven or six acclamations.
- **No order that kept the offertory or the canon** as the priest's prayer of sacrifice. What the Latin-frame orders kept is described in Chapter 7.
- **No evangelical Mass without communicants** (§2.14), except the Hof schoolboys' daily exercise, which has no consecration.
- **No fixed Lutheran ordo.** Even within a family the orders allow the minister to drop the Gloria, the Preface, the Sanctus or the exhortation "when it will grow too long". The tables give the full form each order prescribes; few churches will have sung all of it every Sunday.

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## 2.3 The baselines: the Roman ordo and Luther's two Masses

### 2.3.1 The Roman ordo in outline

**What the reformers inherited.** The orders measure themselves against the late medieval Roman Mass, which they call *die messe*, *das ampt* or *die hohe messe*. In outline it ran:

1. the priest's preparation at the altar (*Introibo*, Psalm 43, *Confiteor*);
2. introit, Kyrie (nine acclamations), Gloria;
3. salutation and collect(s);
4. epistle, gradual, alleluia or tract, sequence;
5. gospel, Nicene Creed (intoned by the priest, continued by the choir);
6. offertory and offertory prayers, the secret;
7. Preface dialogue (*Dominus vobiscum*, *Sursum corda*, *Gratias agamus*), Preface, Sanctus with Benedictus;
8. the canon, with the Words of Institution said silently and the elevation;
9. Lord's Prayer with its introduction (*Praeceptis salutaribus*) and embolism (*Libera nos*), the fraction, the Pax (*Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*), Agnus Dei (three times, the third ending *dona nobis pacem*);
10. communion, communion chant, postcommunion;
11. *Ite missa est* (or *Benedicamus Domino* when there was no Gloria), blessing.

The sermon had no fixed place in the Roman Mass. Every evangelical order gave it one.

#### 2.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the Latin Mass purged

**Keep the ordinaries, cut the sacrifice.** Luther's Latin order of 1523 kept almost everything before the creed "because it is ours and free". It cut the offertory and the canon, and moved the Words of Institution into the Preface. The ordinaries stayed, sung by the choir "with various melodies for the various seasons". **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Secundo, kyrieleison, ut hactenus celebratum est, variis melodiis pro diversis temporibus amplectimur cum sequenti hymno angelico 'Gloria in excelsis, tamen in arbitrio stabit episcopi, quoties illum omitti voluerit.

Secondly, the Kyrie eleison, as it hath been celebrated hitherto, with various melodies for the various seasons, we embrace, together with the angelic hymn following, *Gloria in excelsis*; yet it shall stand in the bishop's judgment how often he will have it left out.

The rest of the order is described in Chapter 7, §7.3. In outline (Sehling 1, pp. 5–6):

- introit, Kyrie, Gloria, one collect, epistle;
- a gradual of two verses with the alleluia; no sequences but *Grates nunc omnes*, *Sancti Spiritus* and *Veni sancte Spiritus*, at the bishop's pleasure;
- gospel, the Nicene Creed ("not displeasing" if sung, but at the bishop's choice), and the sermon either after the creed or before the introit;
- the preparation of bread and wine "during the creed or after" (*sub symbolo vel post*), in the accustomed manner;
- *Dominus vobiscum*, *Sursum corda*, the Preface, and the Words of Institution sung in the Preface tone;
- the Sanctus, with the elevation during the Benedictus;
- the Lord's Prayer, without the *Libera nos*, the fraction or the commixture, then at once *Pax Domini*, "a kind of public absolution";
- the communion during the Agnus Dei; the postcommunion *Quod ore sumpsimus* or *Corpus tuum*;
- *Benedicamus Domino* for *Ite missa est*, and the blessing.

The last item is Luther's replacement for the dismissal. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

> Loco 'Ite missa' dicatur: 'Benedicamus domino', adiecto (ubi et quando placet) alleluia in suis melodiis. Vel ex vespertinis 'Benedicamus' mutuentur. VIII. Benedictio solita detur. Vel accipiatur illa Numeri 6. quam ipse dominus digessit, d.: 'Benedicat nos dominus et custodiat nos, ostendat nobis faciem suam et misereatur nostri, convertat dominus faciem suam ad nos et det nobis pacem.' Vel illa psal. 96.: 'Benedicat nos deus deus noster, benedicat nos deus et metuant eum omnes fines terrae. Amen.

In the place of *Ite missa* let *Benedicamus Domino* be said, with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its melodies; or let the *Benedicamus* be borrowed from Vespers. Eighthly, let the accustomed blessing be given. Or let that of Numbers 6 be taken, which the Lord himself set in order, saying: "The Lord bless us and keep us, the Lord show us his face and have mercy upon us, the Lord turn his face unto us and give us peace." Or that of Psalm 96 [67]: "God, even our own God, shall bless us; God shall bless us, and all the ends of the earth shall fear him. Amen."

#### 2.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: the German Mass for the people

**Three Kyries, German hymns, the Verba with the distribution.** The *Deutsche Messe* made a different shape, for the parishes. A German psalm or hymn stood for the introit; the Kyrie was cut to three acclamations; the Gloria was gone; a German hymn followed the epistle and "Wir glauben all" the gospel; the Preface was replaced by a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and an exhortation; the Words of Institution were sung, the bread given after the words over the bread and the cup after the words over the cup, with German hymns during each; and the service ended with a collect and the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 1, pp. 14–16). Of the Kyrie it says. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Darauf! kyrie eleison, auch im selben thon, drei mal und nicht neun mal, wie folget. Kyrie eleison.

Thereupon the Kyrie eleison, also in the same tone, three times and not nine times, as followeth: Kyrie eleison.

The German Sanctus "Jesaia dem Propheten" and "Christe du Lamm Gottes" belong to the distribution and its close (§§2.10, 2.12; Chapter 8, §§8.12, 8.15).

#### 2.3.4 The three side by side

| Part | Roman Mass | *Formula missae* 1523 | *Deutsche Messe* 1526 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Opening | *Introibo*, *Confiteor* | (priest's private preparation, unregulated) | — |
| Introit | Latin antiphon and psalm | Latin, Sunday and feast introits | German psalm or hymn |
| Kyrie | ninefold, seasonal chant | "various melodies for various seasons" | threefold, "not nine times" |
| Gloria | Sundays and feasts | kept; bishop may omit | omitted |
| Collect | one or more | one only | one, in German |
| Epistle | sung | sung | read facing the people |
| Between the readings | gradual, alleluia, tract, sequence | gradual of two verses, alleluia; few sequences | German hymn |
| Gospel | sung | sung | read facing the people |
| Creed | Nicene, Latin | Nicene, at the bishop's choice | "Wir glauben all" |
| Sermon | — | after the creed or before the introit | after the creed |
| Offertory, secret | yes | cut | cut |
| Preface | yes | yes, with the Verba in the Preface tone | replaced by paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and exhortation |
| Sanctus | with Benedictus, before the canon | after the Verba, elevation during Benedictus | German Sanctus during the distribution |
| Canon | yes | cut | cut |
| Lord's Prayer | after the canon | after the Sanctus | paraphrased before the Verba |
| Pax | before the Agnus | after the Lord's Prayer, as absolution | — |
| Agnus Dei | three times, before communion | during communion | German Agnus after the cup |
| Postcommunion | yes | *Quod ore* or *Corpus tuum* | German collect |
| Dismissal | *Ite missa est* | *Benedicamus Domino* | — |
| Blessing | yes | usual, or Num 6, or Ps 67 | Num 6 |

## 2.4 The families of evangelical ordo

**Seven shapes.** The orders fall into families. Within each, later orders copy earlier ones, often word for word. The families differ less in what they cut than in where they put what they kept: the sermon, the Preface and Sanctus, the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution.

#### 2.4.1 The Saxon Mass: Latin and German together

**Wittenberg and the Albertine orders.** The Wittenberg town order of 1533, Duke Henry's order of 1539 and the Albertine *Kirchenordnung* of 1580 keep the Latin Mass of the *Formula missae* for the school and graft the German pieces of the *Deutsche Messe* on to it. The common pattern:

- introit (Latin, or a German psalm), Kyrie, Gloria with the Latin *Et in terra*;
- a German collect, the epistle sung or read in German facing the people;
- an alleluia, sequence or German hymn;
- the gospel in German; the priest intones *Credo in unum Deum*, the scholars sing the Latin *Patrem*, and the people "Wir glauben all";
- the sermon; then, for the communicants, the paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer and the exhortation from the *Deutsche Messe* (Saxony 1539, 1580), or the Lord's Prayer sung (Wittenberg 1533);
- the Words of Institution sung in German;
- the distribution, with the Latin Agnus Dei and the German Sanctus, "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", "Gott sei gelobet" and Psalm 111;
- "Christe du Lamm Gottes", a German collect, the Aaronic blessing.

The Preface survives here only for the feasts. At Wittenberg "the Preface may well often be left out, that we may the more diligently attend to the Lord's Supper, for that alone is the matter" (Sehling 1, p. 704). Duke Henry's order allows a Latin Preface "on the feasts, and now and then on Sundays" (Sehling 1, p. 274). The Albertine order of 1580 has none (Sehling 1, pp. 368–369). On the Saxon Kyrie and Creed see §§2.6, 2.9.

### 2.4.2 Bugenhagen's northern Mass

**Braunschweig, Hamburg, Lübeck, Pomerania, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Mecklenburg.** Bugenhagen's orders (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535, Denmark 1537, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543) and the Mecklenburg order of 1552 make the Mass of the northern towns. Its marks:

- a confession and absolution, or a prayer at the altar, before the introit (Mecklenburg 1552, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: Chapter 3, §3.4);
- Kyrie and Gloria in Latin or German, the Gloria "at times and not always" (Pomerania 1535);
- the creed intoned by the priest, the Latin *Patrem* sung "*dominicaliter*, in full", then "Wir glauben" (Pomerania 1535, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543, Mecklenburg 1552);
- the sermon, with the general prayer at its end;
- a Preface and Sanctus that are allowed but not required;
- the exhortation to the communicants, the Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution sung together;
- the distribution with "O Lamm Gottes", "Jesus Christus", "Gott sei gelobet" or Psalm 111; "Christe du Lamm Gottes" after it; a collect and the Aaronic blessing.

The Pomeranian order puts the Preface, the Sanctus and the exhortation at the minister's discretion, and allows him to go straight from the sermon hymn to the Lord's Prayer "as is also done at Wittenberg". **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

> Denne singet me de prefatio latinisch överst nicht alle tidt, sunder went me will, sunderlick to den hogen festen, mit dem sanctus latinisch eder düdesch, unde dar na list men de exhortation dat sacrament betrepende mit korte. Lange singent dar etlike prestere lust to hebben, schal ut orsake vormeeden werden, dat sulke christlike unde heelsamen ceremonien dem volke lüstich bliven, unde nicht vordreetlick werden, dat me ock dat volk vormane, gern dar to blivende bet tor lesten benedictien eder segen. Dar umme wen dat volk na der predikie dat düdesche leed gesungen hefft, mach wol de prester to tiden unde vakene dat andere alto male staen laten, ock des exhortatio eder confessio, dat dit nicht to lank unde vordreetlick werde, unde lieven balde an: Lat uns beden, Vader unse etc., alse ock to Wittemberch wert geholden.

Then the Preface is sung in Latin, but not always, rather when one will, especially at the high feasts, with the Sanctus in Latin or German; and thereafter the exhortation concerning the sacrament is read, briefly. Long singing, wherein some priests have pleasure, shall for this cause be avoided: that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not grow wearisome, and that the people also be exhorted to remain there gladly until the last benediction or blessing. Therefore, when the people after the sermon have sung the German song, the priest may at times and often let all the rest

stand over, even the exhortation or confession, that this be not too long and wearisome, and begin straightway: Let us pray, Our Father, etc., as is also kept at Wittenberg.

The Mecklenburg order of 1552 is the fullest of the family, and gives the Latin text and notes of the creed and the Preface (§§2.9, 2.10).

### 2.4.3 The Franconian Mass: Nürnberg and Brandenburg-Ansbach

**A Mass without a Preface.** The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and its descendants (the Nürnberg agendas, Hof 1592) keep the Latin ordinaries for the schools but make the communion its own action, "the order of the Lord's Supper", after the sermon. Its marks:

- the priest says a *Confiteor* privately and reads the introit, the Kyrie and the *Et in terra*, which the scholars sing in Latin or the people in German;
- *Dominus vobiscum* and one or more German collects;
- the epistle and gospel read as chapters in course, "the first chapter of the epistle to the Romans" and so on, not the Sunday pericopes (Chapter 4, §4.5);
- the Credo sung in Latin by the scholars, or "Wir glauben" by the people; the sermon;
- no Preface: the exhortation, then the Words of Institution sung;
- **the Sanctus after the Words of Institution**, then the Lord's Prayer with its old Latin introduction, and the Pax;
- the distribution during the Agnus Dei; collect; *Benedicamus*; one of several blessings.

**Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 196–197):

> Darnach folgt das Sanctus lateinisch oder teutsch. Darauf alsbald: Oremus preceptis salutaribus moniti et divina institutione formati audemus dicere: Pater noster. […] Darnach als bald: Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum etc. oder aber teutsch, wie es hernach notiert ist

Thereafter followeth the Sanctus in Latin or German. Thereupon straightway: *Oremus, praeceptis salutaribus moniti et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere: Pater noster.* […] Thereafter straightway: *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*, etc., or else in German, as it is noted hereafter.

The order of Hof (1592) keeps the Franconian shape, but moves the Lord's Prayer and the Pax before the Words of Institution, and sings the Sanctus and Agnus Dei of the season during the distribution (Sehling 11, pp. 425–426).

### 2.4.4 The Prussian Mass of 1525: the Words of Institution in the Preface

**The *Formula missae* in German.** The Prussian articles of 1525 follow the *Formula missae* in setting the Words of Institution inside the Preface, sung in German, with the elevation, the Sanctus after it, and the Pax as an absolution. They add three peculiarities: the Kyrie sung in Greek, Latin and German, the creed not intoned by the priest, and the Agnus Dei sung only twice (§§2.6, 2.9, 2.12). **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Volgt die prefation, welche der priester deütsch singet samt den evangelischen worten der gebenedeiung oder consecration oder brod und wein (den offertorium, secret, canon minor und maior werden notwendig ausgelassen). Auf die volendeten prefation und consecration gibt man ein zeichen mit der schellen, darnach so bald elevirt der priester beideteil des sacraments ane mittel nacheinander. Unter des und so bald die prefation samt der evangelischen benediction aus ist, singet der chor sanctus deütsch oder lateinisch nach gelegenheit, mit wenig noten.

Then followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German, together with the evangelical words of the blessing or consecration of bread and wine (for the offertory, the secret, the lesser and greater canon are of necessity left out). When the Preface and consecration are ended, a sign is given with the bell; then straightway the priest elevateth both parts of the sacrament, one after the other, without delay. Meanwhile, and as soon as the Preface together with the evangelical benediction is ended, the choir singeth the Sanctus in German or Latin as occasion serveth, with few notes.

The Livonian towns took over the Prussian order at Wolmar in 1533 (Sehling 5, pp. 15–16).

### 2.4.5 The Mass that kept the Latin frame

**Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, the Palatinate before 1556.** A group of orders of the 1540s kept more of the Latin Mass than Wittenberg did: the Preface dialogue, the Pax, the Agnus Dei three times, even the old prayers before communion. The Brandenburg order of 1540 and the Pfalz-Neuburg order of 1543 are treated in Chapter 7, §§7.12, 7.14. The provisional order of the Palatinate (1546, Lutheran; not an Interim order) even kept the tail of the secret, *per omnia saecula*, before the Preface dialogue. **Palatinate, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546** (Sehling 14, pp. 96–97):

> Nach der predig soll geschehen ein ermanung an die communicanten aus hertzog Ottheinrichs kirchenordnung oder dergleichen vor dem altar und hebt alsdann an zu singen: per omnia secula, chorus: amen, der prister: Dominus vobiscum, chorus: et cum spiritu tuo, priester: sursum corda, corus: habemus ad Dominum, prister: gratias agamus domino Deo nostro, chorus: dignum et iustum est, prister: vere dignum et iustum est etc. Und uf den hohen festen singt der priester die gantze prefation, der chor das noch das sanctus bis uf das agnus Dei, darnach hebe der prister an zu singen teutsch das vaterunser in gemeinem thon

After the sermon there shall be made an exhortation to the communicants out of Duke Ottheinrich's church order, or the like, before the altar; and then [the priest] beginneth to sing: *Per omnia saecula*; the choir: *Amen*; the priest: *Dominus vobiscum*; the choir: *Et cum spiritu tuo*; the priest: *Sursum corda*; the choir: *Habemus ad Dominum*; the priest: *Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro*; the choir: *Dignum et iustum est*; the priest: *Vere dignum et iustum est*, etc. And on the high feasts the priest singeth the whole Preface, and the choir thereafter the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei; thereafter the priest beginneth to sing in German the Our Father in the common tone.

The Breslau churches went further still. A report of 1557 says that the Sunday high Mass was sung by a chaplain "in his habit, as of old", through the gospel and the *Patrem*; then came the sermon; "the sermon ended, the chaplain singeth the Preface; after the sermon he elevateth the sacrament"; and the Mass closed with the Sanctus, Agnus Dei and communion chant, the postcommunion, "and with the *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est*" (Sehling 3, p. 404).

### 2.4.6 The Upper German preaching service with communion

**Württemberg, Baden, Strasbourg and their neighbours.** These are Lutheran orders: "Upper German" here names the south-western shape of service, not the Moderate Reformed tradition. The Württemberg order of 1553 (and its copies in Baden 1556, Mömpelgard 1560 and the Palatinate of 1556) has no introit, Kyrie, Gloria, epistle, Preface, Sanctus or Agnus Dei. The service is the sermon service of every Sunday, to which the communion is added:

1. a German hymn ("Komm heiliger Geist", "Nun bitten wir" or a psalm "agreeable to the season");
2. the sermon, which on communion days includes "a short instruction" on the Supper;
3. the creed sung in German;
4. the exhortation to the communicants, read at the altar;
5. the general prayer, then "the church shall sing the Our Father in German together";
6. the public confession and absolution;
7. the Words of Institution read "with loud, understandable voice";
8. the distribution, with "Gott sei gelobet", "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" or another hymn;
9. a thanksgiving prayer and the blessing, in one of three forms.

(Sehling 16, pp. 252–255.) The opening rubric is quoted in Chapter 8, §8.3.4. Strasbourg in 1598 keeps the same shape: the ordinary Sunday service "until the hymn after the sermon"; then the pastor goes to the altar while the church sings the German *Grates nunc omnes*, and reads the Württemberg exhortation (Sehling 20/1, pp. 611–612).

### 2.4.7 The Reformed Supper

**The Palatinate after 1563.** The Palatine order of 1563 (Reformed), and the Reformed orders that copied it (Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598), keep nothing of the ordinaries. After the sermon on the Supper and the Sunday prayer, the minister reads at the table the "Form for holding the holy Supper":

- the Words of Institution from 1 Corinthians 11, with the self-examination and the list of those excluded;
- the doctrine of the Supper; a prayer ending in the Lord's Prayer;
- the Apostles' Creed, "with mouth and heart";
- a lifting up of hearts "into heaven, where Christ Jesus is", in place of the *Sursum corda*;

- the breaking of the bread with the words of 1 Corinthians 10:16;
- singing, or the reading of John 14–18 or Isaiah 53, during the distribution;
- a thanksgiving from Psalm 103 and a closing prayer. Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) adds: "After all this the psalm is sung, and thereafter the blessing of the Lord spoken" (Sehling 22, p. 275).

The breaking replaced the distribution formula. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 386):

> Hie soll der kirchendiener einem jeden vom brodt des herrn brechen und im darreichen sprechen: Das brodt, das wir brechen, ist die gemeinschaft des leibs Christi. Und der ander kirchendiener im darreichen deß kelchs sprechen: Der kelch der dancksagung, damit wir dancksagen, ist die gemeinschaft des bluts Christi

Here shall the minister of the church break of the bread of the Lord to every one, and in giving it say: The bread which we break is the communion of the body of Christ. And the other minister of the church, in giving the cup, [shall] say: The cup of thanksgiving, wherewith we give thanks, is the communion of the blood of Christ.

The Bentheim-Tecklenburg order of 1588 (Reformed) has the same form and the same words (Sehling 22, pp. 271–275).

#### 2.4.8 The early German Masses

**Before the territorial orders.** The German Masses of 1522–1526 (Kantz at Nördlingen, Müntzer at Allstedt (Radical Reformation), the Strasbourg and Worms Masses (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht and Döber at Nürnberg, the Low German Masses of Bremen, Lippe and Kiel) are compared part by part in Chapter 7, §§7.2–7.11. They keep the Roman shape and translate it, the canon included, before the *Deutsche Messe* set the pattern for the parishes. Two of their ordinaries recur below: Müntzer's fourfold Kyrie (§2.6.1) and Volprecht's *Benedicamus* "and never *Ite missa est*" (§2.13).

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## 2.5 The ordos compared

**How to read the table.** Each row gives the sequence of the Sunday Mass with communicants, in the shorthand set out in the Conventions. Brackets mark a part the order allows but does not require. "→" separates the parts. Details of each ordinary are in §§2.6–2.13; the propers, hymns and prayers in the chapters named at the head of this chapter.

| Order | Sehling | Family | Ordo |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, pp. 5–6 | Latin, purged | Intr → Ky (seasonal) → Gl (bishop may omit) → one Coll → Ep → Grad + Alleluia → Gosp → Nicene Cr (optional) → Serm (or before the Intr) → Pref with Verba → San with Benedictus (elevation) → PN → Pax → Comm with Agn → *Quod ore* → *Benedicamus* → Bl |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1, pp. 14–16 | German | German psalm → Ky ×3 → Coll → Ep → German hymn → Gosp → "Wir glauben" → Serm → paraphrase of PN + Exh → Verba (bread) → Comm with German San → Verba (cup) → Comm → German Agn → Thanks → Bl (Num 6) |
| Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525 | 4, pp. 31–33 | Prussian | Intr → Ky ×3 (Greek, Latin, German) → Gl → Coll → Ep (a chapter) → Alleluia with German psalm → Gosp (a chapter) → Cr in German, not intoned → Pref with Verba → bell, elevation → San → PN → Agn ×2 → Pax → Exh → Comm with hymns → Thanks → Bl |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, pp. 188–198 | Franconian | private *Confiteor* → Intr → Ky + *Et in terra* → *Dominus vobiscum* → Coll(s) → Ep (a chapter) → Alleluia or Grad → Gosp (a chapter) → Cr → Serm → Exh → Verba → San → *Oremus praeceptis* + PN → Pax → Comm with Agn → Thanks → *Benedicamus* → Bl |
| Wittenberg, town order, 1533 | 1, pp. 704–705 | Saxon | German Benedictus → Intr → Ky ×3, or ×9 on feasts → [Gl] → German Coll → Ep → Alleluia/Grad, German hymn, sequence → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" → Serm → *Da pacem* → versicle + Coll → [*Dominus vobiscum* + Pref on feasts] → PN → Verba |

| Order | Sehling | Family | Ordo |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | (elevation) → Comm with hymns, Latin Agn → German Agn ×3 → Thanks → Bl (Num 6) |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4, p. 341 | Bugenhagen | German psalm or Intr → Ky → [Gl] → German Coll → Ep → psalm, alleluia, sequence → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wi löven" → Serm + general prayer → hymn → [Pref + San] → [Exh] → PN + Verba → Comm with Agn and hymns → German Agn → Coll → Bl (Num 6); "after the Amen nothing more is sung" |
| Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539 | 1, pp. 274–275 | Saxon | Intr → Ky (seasonal, or ×3) → Gl + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → Gosp → Latin *Patrem* + "Wir glauben" → Serm → [Latin Pref on feasts] → paraphrase of PN + Exh (or PN sung) → Verba → Comm with Latin Agn or German hymns → German Agn → Coll → Bl → "Gott sei gelobet" |
| Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540 | 3, pp. 68–70 | Latin frame | Intr → Ky → Gl + *Et in terra* → *Dominus vobiscum* + Coll → Ep → Alleluia + sequence → Gosp → *Credo*, *Patrem* (German in parishes) → *Dominus vobiscum* without *Oremus* → offertory chant → Pref → Latin San (prayers said under it) → Verba (German, elevation) → PN (German) → Pax → Agn ×3 → Exh → Comm with *Discubuit Jesus* → Thanks → *Quod ore* |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 54–56 | Bugenhagen | German Benedictus → German psalm → Ky ×3 (prayer at the altar) → Gl intoned, *Et in terra*, "Allein Gott", *Laudamus* → one Coll → Ep → Alleluia, German psalm, [sequence] → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wy geloven" → Serm → Exh → … (as Pomerania) |
| Palatinate, *Gemaine maß*, 1546 | 14, pp. 96–97 | Latin frame | versicle + Coll → Intr → Ky (each once) → *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → Alleluia + sequence or tract → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, Latin Nicene Cr, "Wir glauben" → Serm → Exh → *Per omnia saecula*, *Dominus vobiscum*, *Sursum corda* → [whole Pref on high feasts] → San to the Agn → PN (German) → Verba → Pax → Comm … |
| Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547 | 24, p. 244 | Saxon | German Benedictus (or *Salve festa dies*) → Intr → Ky + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep → sequence or tract → Gosp → "Wir glauben" or Latin *Credo* → *Dominus vobiscum*, Pref, San → PN → Verba → Agn, hymns during Comm → *Dominus vobiscum*, Coll → *Benedicamus* → Trinitarian Bl; the sermon is held before the Mass, after Matins, and again after dinner |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, pp. 198–199 | Bugenhagen | confession and absolution → Intr → Ky → Gl or "Allein Gott" → *Dominus vobiscum* → German Coll → Ep → sequence or hymn → Gosp → *Credo* intoned, *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" → Serm (about an hour) + prayer → [*Dominus vobiscum* + Pref + San] → [Exh] → PN + Verba sung (no elevation) → Comm with hymns, Agn, Isaiah → "Christe du Lamm Gottes" → Thanks → Bl (Num 6) → "Erhalt uns" |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16, pp. 252–255 | Upper German | German hymn → Serm → German Cr → Exh → general prayer → "Vater unser" sung → confession and absolution → Verba read → Comm with hymns → Thanks → Bl |
| Breslau, report on the order of the churches, 1557 | 3, p. 404 | Latin frame | high Mass sung "as of old" to the Gosp and *Patrem* → Serm → Pref → elevation → Comm → San, Agn, communion chant → postcommunion → *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est* |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 | 14, pp. 383–387 | Reformed | Serm on the Supper → Sunday prayer → the Form: Verba (1 Cor 11), self-examination, exclusion → prayer + PN → Apostles' Cr → hearts |

| Order | Sehling | Family | Ordo |
|---|---|---|---|
| (Reformed) | | | lifted up → breaking of bread (1 Cor 10:16) → Comm with singing or reading → Thanks (Ps 103) + prayer |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 237–254 | Hessian | confession and absolution, or Ps 51 → German Ky + Gl → Coll → Ep → psalm or sequence → Gosp → Apostles' Cr sung by all → Serm → general prayer → confession → notices and alms → Supper |
| Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 368–369 | Saxon | Intr → Ky → Latin Gl + *Et in terra* → Coll → Ep (German) → sequence or psalm → Gosp (German) → *Credo*, Latin *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" → Serm → paraphrase of PN + Exh → Verba sung → Comm with Latin Agn, Isaiah, Ps 111, hymns → Coll → Bl (Num 6) |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 (Reformed) | 22, pp. 271–275 | Reformed | as the Palatinate 1563 → psalm → Bl |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 425–426 | Franconian | Intr → Ky de tempore (three choirs) → Gl intoned, *Et in terra* in alternation → epistle prayer + Ep → German psalm → gospel prayer + Gosp → "Wir glauben" → "Nun bitten wir" kneeling → Serm → *Dominus vobiscum* + Coll → Exh → PN → Pax → Verba → Comm with San and Agn de tempore, Isaiah, hymns |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, pp. 610–612 | Upper German | Sunday sermon service to the prayer after the Serm → German *Grates nunc omnes* while the bread and wine are set out → Exh (Württemberg text) → … |

**What the table shows.**

- **Everyone kept the readings, the sermon, the Verba and a closing blessing.** The epistle and gospel (or chapters in course), a sermon, the Words of Institution, a distribution with singing, a thanksgiving and a blessing are in every row.
- **The ordinaries divide the families.** The Saxon, Bugenhagen, Franconian, Prussian and Latin-frame orders keep Kyrie, Gloria and Creed, and some form of Sanctus and Agnus Dei. The Upper German (Lutheran) and Reformed orders keep only a creed: the German "Wir glauben" in Württemberg, the Apostles' Creed in the Reformed Palatinate.
- **The Preface was the first casualty.** Only the Prussian, Franconian-Hof, Latin-frame and Transylvanian orders require it. The Saxon and Bugenhagen orders make it optional or festal; the *Deutsche Messe*, Albertine Saxony 1580, Nürnberg 1533 and Württemberg drop it (§2.10).
- **The Verba and the Lord's Prayer travel.** The Lord's Prayer comes before the Verba (Saxony, Bugenhagen, Transylvania, Hof), after them (*Formula missae*, Prussia, Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540), as a paraphrase in the exhortation (*Deutsche Messe*, Saxony 1539, 1580), as a hymn before the confession (Württemberg), or inside the prayer before the creed (Palatinate, Reformed) (§2.11).
- **The sermon has two homes.** It follows the gospel and creed almost everywhere. The *Formula missae* allowed it before the introit, and Transylvania (1547) held the first sermon after Matins, before the Mass began (Sehling 24, p. 244).

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## 2.6 The Kyrie

The hymns sung as or with the Kyrie, the troped German Kyries and the Kyrie in three tongues are treated in Chapter 8, §8.6. This section asks how many acclamations were sung, and which of the old Kyrie chants survived.

### 2.6.1 Three, four or nine

**The medieval norm was nine.** The Roman Kyrie had nine acclamations: Kyrie three times, Christe three times, Kyrie three times. The Hannover order of 1536 repeats the common attribution: "To sing the Kyrie eleison nine times, Gregory the Great set up in the Roman church, as Platina writeth; yet it came first from the Greek church" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1005).

**Luther: three, not nine.** The *Deutsche Messe* cut the Kyrie to three acclamations, "three times and not nine times" (§2.3.3). The threefold Kyrie became the norm of the German parish service:

- Duke Henry's Saxony (1539): "on ordinary Sundays and in the villages one may sing it plain … only three times" (Sehling 1, p. 274);
- the visitation articles for Gnandstein (1539) and the *Gemeine Artikel* for the see of Wurzen (1542): "Kyrie eleison three times" (Sehling 1, p. 564; 2, p. 98);
- Prussia (1525, 1544 and 1568): "since it is sung three times", in three tongues (1525); "the Kyrie eleison only three times, according to the former order" (1544, 1568) (Sehling 4, pp. 32, 64, 81);
- the Palatinate (1546): "the Kyrie eleison, each only once" (Sehling 14, p. 96);
- the Henneberg parishes of Suhl (1562) and Obermaßfeld (1563): "the German Kyrie three times" (Sehling 2, pp. 352, 346);
- Waldeck (1556): "a Kyrie eleison three times" (Sehling 9, p. 247).

**Nine on the feasts.** The ninefold Kyrie survived where there was a choir, and especially on feasts. At Wittenberg the plain threefold Kyrie was "the right Kyrie", the ninefold the festal one (Sehling 1, p. 704; quoted in §2.7.1). The Pomeranian order of 1542 gives the Sunday Kyrie "three or nine times, or the Kyrie of the feast" (Sehling 4, p. 358). The Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 gives the reason for three, and leaves the festal number to the schoolmaster. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

> Id is nicht van nöden, negen mal dat eleison edder Kyrie tho repetirende, yd is genoch dremal im namen des Vaders und des Sons und des hilgen Geistes tho singende ane orgelen. Doch mögen de scholere in festis wol ein ander Kyrie singen, besundern, wenn se in figurativis singen, dremal, veermal edder ock negenmal na gevallen des scholemeisters, also doch, dat man yd mit dem singen und orgelen nicht tho lange make, dat de predike darmede nicht vorhindert werde.

It is not needful to repeat the *eleison* or Kyrie nine times; it is enough to sing it three times, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, without the organ. Yet the scholars may well sing another Kyrie on the feasts, especially when they sing in figured music, three times, four times or nine times, at the schoolmaster's pleasure; yet so that one make it not too long with the singing and the organ, that the sermon be not hindered thereby.

**Four.** A fourfold form, Kyrie, Christe, Kyrie, Kyrie, appears in three places:

- Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* of 1524 (Radical Reformation): "Kyrie leyson, Christe leyson, kyrie leyson, kyrie leyson" (Sehling 1, p. 499);
- the German Masses of the Calenberg-Göttingen order of 1542, which take the chants of Müntzer (Radical Reformation): some have the fourfold form, others the threefold (Sehling 6/2, pp. 812, 817, 825, 827, 829; three: pp. 820, 823, 832);
- the song appendix of the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist), after the German introit for Trinity: "Kyrie eleison. Christe eleison. Kyrie eleison. Kyrie eleison" (Sehling 8, p. 465).

The fourth acclamation is the closing Kyrie of the chant, sung to its own melody, kept when the middle repetitions were cut. Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel's "four times" in figured music (above) is the same shape set polyphonically.

**One, by three choirs.** At Hof (1592) the German Kyrie was divided among three choirs, one acclamation each: "the first choir singeth Kyrie eleison in German, the second Christe eleison, the third, or the girls' choir, Kyrie eleison". In figured music the organ played each of the three before the choir answered; otherwise the organ "preludeth once only before the *Et in terra*" (Sehling 11, p. 425).

**Not found.** No order prescribes a sevenfold Kyrie, and none a sixfold one. The counts in the corpus are three, four and nine, with the "each once" of the Palatinate (1546) amounting to three.

### 2.6.2 Which Kyrie: the seasonal chants

**The old melodies kept.** The *Formula missae* kept the Kyrie "with various melodies for the various seasons" (§2.3.2). The northern and Franconian orders name the chants they meant, by their medieval titles. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> Darup dat kyrie dominicale, efft me mach ock up die sondage, kyrie angelicum, de martiribus, effte confessoribus, efft virginibus, ' wo man sie genomet hefft singen, dominicale im advent und in der vasten, dat paschale tuschen pingsten

> und paschen, dat summum up die hohern fest, effte dat minus summum.

Thereupon the *Kyrie dominicale*; or one may also sing on the Sundays the *Kyrie angelicum*, *de martyribus*, or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Easter and Whitsun, the *summum* on the higher feasts, or the *minus summum*.

The fullest scheme is the Hof order of 1592, for the boys' daily Mass-shaped service sung from the "great missal". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 472):

> Mox II. ex missali magno canitur Kyrie certi temporis vel angelicum in Adventu Domini vel Kyrie Magnae Deus potentiae de Nativitate Christi, cui Et in terra angelicum subiicitur, vel Kyrie dominicale maius post dominicam Septuagesimae usque ad Pascha vel Kyrie paschale vel Kyrie Fons bonitatis cum Et in terra angelico vel Kyrie dominicale minus post festum Trinitatis vel de apostolis, martyribus etc., prout tempus requirit et libri ordo monstrat.

Next, secondly, there is sung out of the great missal the Kyrie of the proper season: either the *angelicum* in the Advent of the Lord, or the Kyrie *Magne Deus potentiae* of the Nativity of Christ, to which the angelic *Et in terra* is joined; or the greater *dominicale* from the Sunday Septuagesima until Easter; or the *paschale*; or the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* with the angelic *Et in terra*; or the lesser *dominicale* after the feast of Trinity; or that of the apostles, martyrs, etc., as the season requireth and the order of the book showeth.

The same order assigns, Sunday by Sunday, a "Kyrie angelicum seu feriale" in Advent, a "Kyrie paschale" from Easter to the Ascension, and a "Kyrie dominicale" from the fourth Sunday after Trinity to Advent, with the Sanctus and Agnus Dei of the same set (Sehling 11, pp. 432–450).

**Other lists.**

- **Buxtehude 1526**: a table of the Kyries by occasion: "*In summis festivitatibus et dominica Trinitatis … Minus summum*", "*In festis beatae virginis Mariae*", "*Kyrie paschale*", "*Dominicale*", "*In Adventu Domini*", "*Angelicum*", "*Kyrie apostolicum*" (Sehling 7/1, p. 123).
- **Nördlingen 1544**: German Kyries "according to the season, of which we have three at this time": the *paschale* from Easter to Whitsun, *Fons bonitatis* from Whitsun to Christmas, *Magne Deus* from Christmas to Easter; and the "*Kyrie summum* with the *Et in terra*" at Whitsun and Trinity, with the "*Sanctus summus*" (Sehling 12, pp. 318, 321–322).
- **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1540/1545**: the Kyrie "according to the season, as hath been kept hitherto"; in the villages the pastors are to teach the people "the German *Kyrie summum*, *Ach vader, alder högeste godt*" (Sehling 5, p. 151).
- **Schleswig-Holstein 1542**: "The Kyrie eleison may be sung with manifold notes according to the difference of the season, as hath been kept hitherto" (Sehling 23, p. 90).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557**: the song index lists a *Kyrie paschale*, a Kyrie "*in adventu domini*", an *angelicum* and an *apostolicum*, each with its Gloria (Sehling 18, p. 255). The hymn plan of 1565 marks "the second Kyrie" for ordinary Sundays (Sehling 18, p. 337).
- **Schweinfurt 1576**: the organ begins "the Latin *Kyrie dominicale*, which the choir repeateth" (Sehling 11, pp. 647–648).

So the old cycle of Kyrie chants, *Lux et origo* (*paschale*), *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *Cunctipotens* (*apostolicum*), *Orbis factor* (*dominicale*) and the rest, survived in the Lutheran churches that had Latin schools, assigned to the seasons as before. Where the orders print a text, it is the plain Kyrie, or a new German trope set to the old melody; the old Latin tropes are not printed (Chapter 8, §8.6.4).

### 2.6.3 Which language

**Latin, German, Greek.** The Kyrie is the one ordinary the orders most often leave untranslated. The Homberg synod of 1526 (Moderate Reformed) kept "these accustomed little words, *Kyrie eleyson*, *Hallelujah*, *Hosiannah*, *Sabaoth*, *Amen*", to be explained to the people (Sehling 8, p. 45). Bugenhagen defended the Greek at length (Braunschweig 1528, Sehling 6/1, p. 438; Chapter 8, §8.6.3). Prussia sang it in three languages, "since it is sung three times". **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Von dem kyrieleyson ist fur gut angesehen, dieweil es dreimal gesungen wirt, das es in dreien zungen, wie man auch alhier pfleget, krichisch, lateinisch und deütsch gefangen werde. Gloria in excelsis, und et in terra, mögen deutsch oder

> lateinisch nach bequemigkeit gesungen werden.

Of the Kyrie eleison it is thought good, since it is sung three times, that it be sung in three tongues, as is the custom here also: Greek, Latin and German. *Gloria in excelsis* and *Et in terra* may be sung in German or Latin, as is convenient.

The Livonian towns took the same rule in 1533 (Sehling 5, p. 15).

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## 2.7 The Gloria

The German Gloria hymns ("Allein Gott in der Höh", "All Ehr und Lob"), the alternation of Latin and German Sunday by Sunday, and the omission of the Gloria in Advent, Lent and winter are treated in Chapter 8, §8.7. Three further points belong to the ordo.

### 2.7.1 The Gloria belongs to the festal Kyrie

**Not after the plain Kyrie.** In the medieval Mass the Gloria went with a festal Kyrie and was silent on ferias and penitential days. Wittenberg kept the rule. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> Darnach das rechte kyrie dreimal, oder zu zeiten, besondern uf die feste, ein anders neunmal, wie gewonlich. Auf das schlechte kyrie singet man nicht gloria in excelsis deo, sondern auf andere, wenn man will, und sonderlich uf die feste.

Thereafter the right Kyrie three times; or at times, especially on the feasts, another one nine times, as is customary. After the plain Kyrie one singeth not the *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, but after the others, when one will, and especially on the feasts.

The Brandenburg order of 1540 ties the two together: the Kyrie "according to occasion", then the Gloria, "which together with the *Et in terra* belongeth to the Kyrie" (Sehling 3, p. 68). The *Formula missae* left it to the bishop "how often he will have it left out" (§2.3.2), and the *Deutsche Messe* left it out altogether.

### 2.7.2 Intonation, *Et in terra*, and the divided Gloria

**The priest intones.** Where the Gloria was sung, the priest (or a deacon, or at Hof a boy) intoned *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, and the choir continued *Et in terra pax*. In the German orders the priest sang "Ehre sei Gott in der Höhe" and the people answered with "Allein Gott". The orders of the north divided the Latin Gloria between the scholars, the people and the organ. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 55):

> Na dem Kyrie singet de prester: Gloria in excelsis Deo. Dat scholerchor antwerdet und singet: Et in terra pax, hominibus bona voluntas, nicht mehr. Balde singet de ganze kercke: Alleine Got in der höged sy ehr etc. vul uth.

After the Kyrie the priest singeth: *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. The scholars' choir answereth and singeth: *Et in terra pax hominibus bonae voluntatis*, no more. Straightway the whole church singeth "To God alone on high be glory," etc., in full.

The scholars and the organ then continue the Latin *Laudamus te* "in full" (Sehling 6/1, p. 55). So the Gloria was sung twice over: once in its Latin form, divided between the priest, the scholars and the organ, and once as Decius's hymn by the people. The Pomeranian order of 1542 allows either half to be dropped "when it will grow too long" (Sehling 4, p. 356).

**At Hof**, the minister intoned a Gloria "suited to the Mass and answering to the season"; the organ began the *Et in terra*, "divided into certain portions", which the three choirs finished in alternation with the organ. In the hardest frost the organ only began it and the choir sang the rest (Sehling 11, p. 425).

### 2.7.3 The Gloria and the Kyrie as one piece

**One unit.** Because the Gloria followed the Kyrie and shared its chant, several orders treat the two as a single piece: "the Kyrie and the *Et in terra*" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Kurpfalz 1546; Transylvania 1547; Nördlingen 1544), "Kyrie eleison with the *Gloria in excelsis et in terra pax*, as it is put into German and printed in the song-books" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed, Sehling 8, p. 239). The Hof order of 1592 assigns to each seasonal Kyrie its own *Et in terra*: "the Kyrie *Magne Deus potentiae* … to which the angelic *Et in terra* is joined" (§2.6.2). In East Frisia (1535) the Kyrie and Gloria together were sung "as it is sung in the song *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr*" (Chapter 8, §8.6.5).

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## 2.8 Salutation, collect and Pax

The collect and postcommunion are treated in Chapter 5. Here the fixed formulas around them.

**The salutation.** *Dominus vobiscum* before the collect survived in most of the Latin-shaped orders, often given in German beside the Latin:

- Mecklenburg 1552: "*Dominus vobiscum*, or *Der herr sei mit euch*. Chorus: *Et cum spiritu tuo*, or *Und mit deinem geiste*" (Sehling 5, p. 198);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533: "*Dominus vobiscum* or *Der Herr sei mit euch*" (Sehling 11, p. 188);
- Hof 1592: "*Der Herr sei mit euch!* Chorus: *Und mit deinem geist*", sung "either chorally or figurally" (Sehling 11, p. 425);
- Transylvania 1547: before the Preface and again before the postcommunion collect (Sehling 24, p. 244).

Bugenhagen's Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order dropped it: "*Dominus vobiscum*, or *De Here sy mit ju*, is not needful to say" (Sehling 6/1, p. 55). The *Deutsche Messe* and the Württemberg and Reformed orders have no salutation.

**The Pax.** The *Formula missae* kept *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* after the Lord's Prayer as "a kind of public absolution from sins … the one and most worthy preparation for the Lord's Table" (Sehling 1, p. 6). The Pax stayed where the Lord's Prayer stayed near the altar:

- Prussia 1525: "the priest turneth to the people and giveth them the evangelical absolution, or the peace, and singeth in German *Pax domini*" (Sehling 4, p. 32);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, after the Lord's Prayer: "*Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*, or else in German" (§2.4.3);
- Brandenburg 1540: "*Der fried des herren sei mit euch allen*. Let all the people say *Amen*" (Sehling 3, p. 69);
- the Palatinate 1546, after the Verba: "*der fride deß herrn sei mit euch allen*. The choir answereth: *Amen*" (Sehling 14, p. 97);
- Hof 1592: "*Der frid des Herren sei mit euch allen*" (Sehling 11, p. 426).

The *Deutsche Messe*, the Saxon orders of 1539 and 1580, the Pomeranian and Mecklenburg orders and Württemberg have no Pax.

**The Preface dialogue** is treated with the Preface (§2.10).

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## 2.9 The Creed

The German creed-hymn "Wir glauben all" and its places in the service are treated in Chapter 8, §8.9. This section asks which creed was used, and who began it.

### 2.9.1 Intoned by the priest, sung by the choir, then by the people

**Three layers.** In the Saxon and Bugenhagen orders the creed was sung three times over: the priest intoned the Nicene Creed in Latin at the altar, the scholars sang the Latin *Patrem* to the end, and the people then sang "Wir glauben all". **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> Darnach singt der priester das evangelium zum volk gewandt, darnach widerumb zum altar credo in unum deum. Darauf singen die schuler patrem lateinisch, alsdan mit dem volk wir gleuben alle an einen gott. Oft aber liebt der schulmeister bald auf das evangelium an wir gleuben etc. um der kurz willen.

Thereafter the priest singeth the gospel turned toward the people, thereafter, [turned] again toward the altar, *Credo in unum Deum*. Thereupon the scholars sing the *Patrem* in Latin, then with the people "We all believe in one God". But often the schoolmaster beginneth "We believe", etc., straight after the gospel, for brevity's sake.

The same three layers are in Pomerania 1535 ("the *Patrem* in full, *dominicaliter*"), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543, Duke Henry's Saxony 1539 ("the Latin *Patrem* in full, after the common notes"), Mecklenburg 1552 (with the Latin text and notes), the Palatinate 1546 and Saxony 1580 (Sehling 4, p. 341; 6/1, p. 55; 1, p. 274; 5, p. 198; 14, p. 96; 1, p. 368). Brandenburg (1540) sang the Latin *Patrem* "in cathedrals and foundations", and "Wir glauben" in the parishes (Sehling 3, p. 68).

**Not intoned.** Prussia (1525) abolished the priest's intonation: "The *Credo* or creed the priest shall not begin as heretofore, but it shall be sung in German by the choir and the people" (Sehling 4, p. 32).

### 2.9.2 Nicene, Apostles' or Athanasian

**The Nicene Creed in the Lutheran Mass.** The Latin *Credo* of the Mass is the Nicene Creed, and "Wir glauben all" is Luther's paraphrase of it. Sangerhausen (1555) calls the people's German creed "the customary *Symbolum Nicaenum* in German" (Sehling 1, p. 658). Weissenfels (1578) sometimes sang "the *Symbolum Nicenum*" in figured music before the German creed (Sehling 1, p. 693).

**The Apostles' Creed in Hesse and the Reformed orders.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) put the Apostles' Creed in the Mass, sung by everyone every Sunday, and kept the Nicene and Athanasian Creeds for the feasts of Christ. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 242–243):

> Es wird aber dies symbolum und bekentnus des glaubens von der ganzen kirchen allen sontag mit heller stim nach der lection des evangelii gesungen und dasselbige aus volgenden ursachen […] Auf die feirtage aber Christi mag man singen oder lesen das symbolum Nicenum oder Athanasii, welche dann sehr nütz sein zur sterkung unsers glaubens und zu widerstehen den ketzern, so uf mancherlei weis die ehr und die zwo naturen Christi, des Sohns Gottes angefochten und gelestert haben

But this creed and confession of faith is sung by the whole church every Sunday with clear voice after the reading of the gospel, and that for the following causes […] But on the feasts of Christ one may sing or read the Nicene Creed or that of Athanasius, which are very profitable for the strengthening of our faith and for withstanding the heretics who in manifold ways have assailed and blasphemed the honour and the two natures of Christ, the Son of God.

The Palatine order of 1563 (Reformed) has the communicants confess the Apostles' Creed "with mouth and heart" inside the Supper form (§2.4.7). Nördlingen (1579) had "an article of the Apostles' Creed with the short exposition of Luther's catechism" read before the German creed on feast days (Sehling 12, p. 366).

**The Athanasian Creed** was read or sung on Trinity Sunday in some places: as the text of the early sermon at Schweinfurt (1543) and at Altenburg (1554) (Sehling 11, p. 638; 1, p. 519). Its place was otherwise the morning office (Chapter 10, §10.7).

### 2.9.3 Where the creed fell

After the gospel nearly everywhere; after the sermon in Württemberg, where the creed was sung "in German" when the sermon was over (Sehling 16, p. 252); and inside the Supper form in the Reformed Palatinate. The places of the creed-hymn as offertory, as cover for the preacher's movement to the pulpit, and as a substitute for "Nun bitten wir" are in Chapter 8, §§8.9.1–8.9.4.

### 2.9.4 Which creed, order by order

**Four practices.** A search of the corpus for the creeds named in or near the Mass (*Credo in unum Deum*, *Patrem*, *symbolum Nicenum*, *symbolum apostolicum*, *Credo in Deum Patrem*, "Ich glaub in Gott Vater", *Athanasii*) gives four practices:

- **The Nicene Creed only**, in Latin, in German verse by verse, or as Luther's "Wir glauben all". This is the rule of the Saxon, Bugenhagen and Franconian orders.
- **The Apostles' Creed only**, sung or said: Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed), the foundation Mass at Goslar, the Upper German pulpit, the Reformed Supper.
- **A choice left open**, Nicene or Apostles', Latin or German, with no rule for when.
- **A choice by occasion**: one creed on Sundays, another on feasts.

**Strasbourg: the Apostles' Creed sung, the Nicene by some.** The Strasbourg German Mass of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) prints the Apostles' Creed with notes after the sermon, in Matthäus Greiter's setting, and leaves the Nicene to those who want it. **Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 138):

> Folget die Predig Darnach der Glaub Ich glaub in Got Vater, den almechtigen, schöpffer himmels und der erden […] Das groß Patrem, das man nennt Symbolum Nicenum, würt von etlichen gesungen

Then followeth the sermon. Thereafter the Creed: "I believe in God the Father Almighty, maker of heaven and earth" […] The great *Patrem*, which is called the Nicene Creed, is sung by some.

The earlier Strasbourg Mass of Theobald Schwarz (1524, Moderate Reformed) had the Nicene Creed in German, "Ich glaub in ein Gott, den almechtigen vattern" (Sehling 20/1, p. 121).

**By occasion: Sundays and feasts.** Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) gave the Apostles' Creed to every Sunday and the Nicene or Athanasian to the feasts of Christ (§2.9.2). The Rothenberg ministers of 1618 reversed the scheme: "Wir glauben" on Sundays, the Apostles' Creed word for word on the other feasts. **Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618** (Sehling 13, p. 548):

> Nach abtretung der knaben, sing man die sontäg den gewöhnlichen glauben: Wir glauben all an einen Gott etc. Die andern feiertäg aber das symbolum apostolicum deutsch von worts zu worts: Ich glaub in Gott Vater, allmechtigen etc.

After the boys have stepped down, let the customary creed be sung on the Sundays: "We all believe in one God", etc. But on the other holy days the Apostles' Creed in German, word for word: "I believe in God the Father Almighty", etc.

**A free choice of three.** The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) lets the Apostles' Creed, Luther's creed-hymn or the Nicene be sung after the gospel. On occasion the Nicene or the Athanasian Creed might instead be read aloud at the altar. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

> Auf verlesung des evangelii wird gesungen das symbolum apostolicum teutsch, von wort zu wort, oder wie es Doctor Luther paraphrastice in gesangsweise gestelt hat, oder das symbolum Nicenum teutsch. Man mag auch je bisweilen nach dem evangelio das teutsch Grates nunc omnes, oder einen andern kurzen gesang singen und darauf das symbolum Nicenum oder Athanasianum mit klarer stimm dem volk für dem altar fürlesen

Upon the reading of the gospel is sung the Apostles' Creed in German, word for word, or as Doctor Luther hath set it in the manner of a song by way of paraphrase, or the Nicene Creed in German. One may also now and then, after the gospel, sing the German *Grates nunc omnes*, or another short song, and thereupon read the Nicene or Athanasian Creed with a clear voice to the people before the altar.

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) counts "Wir glauben all" as a paraphrase of the Apostles' Creed, not of the Nicene. The Corvey order for Bruchhausen (1603) does the same: "the Apostles' Creed, as Dr Luther set it in German in the manner of a song", where Sehling's editors identify the song as "Wir glauben all" (Sehling 21, p. 244). Most orders, and the modern editors, take it as the Nicene.

**The table.** The orders that say which creed belongs in the Sunday Mass or service:

| Order | Sehling | Creed | By occasion |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, p. 5 | Nicene, Latin, at the bishop's choice | — |
| Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524 | 11, p. 41 | Nicene in German, "Ich glaub in einen Gott" | — |
| Schwarz, Strasbourg, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 121 | Nicene in German | — |
| Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 138 | Apostles' Creed, sung after the sermon | Nicene "by some" |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1, p. 14 | "Wir glauben all" | — |
| Braunschweig 1528; Hamburg 1529 | 6/1, p. 440; 5, p. 531 | priest intones "Ick love an eynen Got"; people sing the whole Nicene in Low German verse by verse; then "Wy gelöven" | — |
| Goslar, town order, 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 242 | "the Nicene Creed or the German *Patrem*, Wir glauben" | — |

| Order | Sehling | Creed | By occasion |
|---|---|---|---|
| Goslar, foundation of St. Simon and Jude, 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 263 | *Credo in Deum Patrem* (Apostles') after the gospel | — |
| Wittenberg 1533 and the Saxon and Bugenhagen orders | §2.9.1 | *Credo in unum Deum* intoned, Latin *Patrem*, "Wir glauben" | "Wir glauben" alone for brevity |
| Northeim 1539 | 6/2, p. 925 | "the Nicene Creed or Wir glauben in German" | — |
| Brandenburg 1540 | 3, p. 68 | Latin *Patrem* | in cathedrals and foundations; "Wir glauben" in parishes |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1543 (1615 revision) | 17/1, p. 163 | a hymn "with the Apostles' Creed, as a mark of the Church", or "Nun bitten wir", at the start of the Sunday service | — |
| Württemberg 1553 | 16, pp. 239, 252 | German creed sung after the sermon; the Apostles' Creed said from the pulpit every Sunday with the Decalogue and Lord's Prayer | — |
| Frankfurt, French Reformed church, 1554 (Reformed) | 9, p. 567 | Apostles' Creed sung by the people while the bread and wine are brought | — |
| Sangerhausen 1555 | 1, p. 658 | "the customary Nicene Creed in German" | — |
| Hamburg, Latin account, 1556 | 5, p. 543 | *symbolum apostolorum* after the gospel, before the Latin Preface | — |
| Ritzebüttel (Hamburg), 1556 | 5, p. 559 | Apostles' Creed after the gospel | on apostles' days and lesser holy days |
| Feuchtwangen 1563 | 11, p. 399 | *Credo in unum Deum Patrem omnipotentem* one Sunday, the German creed the next | alternating Sundays |
| Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) | 14, p. 386 | Apostles' Creed within the Supper form (§2.4.7) | — |
| Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 242–243, 254 | Apostles' Creed every Sunday; "Wir glauben" or the Apostles' Creed in the shorter service | Nicene or Athanasian on the feasts of Christ |
| Prussia 1568 | 4, p. 81 | Latin Nicene in the cathedral | elsewhere alternating Sunday by Sunday with "Wir glauben" |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4, p. 438 | Nicene in Latin or Low German, or "Wi gelöven" | — |
| Kurland 1570 | 5, p. 88 | Latin *Patrem*, or the Apostles' Creed sung ("Ich gleub an gott vater"), or "Wir gleuben" | — |
| Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8, p. 411 | Apostles' word for word, Luther's paraphrase, or Nicene in German | Nicene or Athanasian sometimes read aloud |
| Weissenfels 1578 | 1, p. 693 | figured Nicene before the German creed | some days |
| Corvey (Bruchhausen) 1603 | 21, p. 244 | "Wir glauben all", called the Apostles' Creed | — |
| Rothenberg 1618 | 13, p. 548 | "Wir glauben all" on Sundays | Apostles' word for word on other feasts |

**What the table shows.**

- The Nicene Creed, sung in Latin by the choir and in German by the people, is the Lutheran norm north and east.

- The Apostles' Creed entered the Mass from three directions:
  - the Upper German sermon service (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed; Schwäbisch Hall and Württemberg's pulpit, Lutheran);
  - the Reformed Supper (Frankfurt's French church, the Palatinate; both Reformed);
  - Hesse (Moderate Reformed), where it was the creed of the whole congregation every Sunday.
- The Athanasian Creed was never the Sunday creed. It was read on the feasts of Christ in Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and on Trinity Sunday in a few places (§2.9.2), and otherwise belonged to the morning office.
- The weekday offices of Naumburg (1537) and Nördlingen (1544, 1579) gave the Nicene Creed its own day, Friday or Thursday, in a weekly round of canticles (Sehling 2, p. 72; 12, pp. 326, 377); that is office, not Mass.

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## 2.10 The Preface and the Sanctus

The Proper Prefaces, their texts and the days they were used, are in Chapter 4, §4.8 and Appendix 4.A; the German Sanctus hymns ("Jesaia dem Propheten", the Trinitarian "Heilig ist Gott der Vater") in Chapter 8, §8.12.

### 2.10.1 The Preface: required, optional, festal or gone

**Four answers.** The orders give four answers to the question whether the Preface was sung:

- **Required.** The *Formula missae*, Prussia 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Transylvania 1547 and the Breslau Mass of 1557 have it in the ordo, with the dialogue (§§2.4.4–2.4.5).
- **If time allows.** Mecklenburg (1552) makes it the priest's choice "if the time permit".
- **Festal.** Wittenberg 1533 (feasts, and Trinity on Sundays "if one will"), Duke Henry's Saxony 1539 ("on the feasts and now and then on Sundays"), Pomerania 1535 ("not always … especially at the high feasts"), the Palatinate 1546 (the whole Preface "on the high feasts", the dialogue always) and the boys' daily service at Hof (from Lossius's book "on the chief festivals") (Sehling 1, pp. 704, 274; 4, p. 341; 14, p. 97; 11, p. 473).
- **Gone.** The *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg 1533, Albertine Saxony 1580, Württemberg and the Reformed orders. The Palatinate's Reformed form (1563) keeps only the idea of the *Sursum corda*, as an exhortation to lift up the heart "into heaven, where Christ Jesus is" (§2.4.7).

The Mecklenburg rubric shows the whole Preface section made optional. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 199):

> So es denn die zeit leidet, mag der priester die prefation singen, deudsch oder latinisch, anzufahen mit diesen worten: Dominus vobiscum, oder Der herr sei mit euch. Und findest die prefationes auch hernach an irem ort bei sammen mit den gewönlichen noten verzeichnet. Darauf wird das sanctus latinisch gesungen, wie es auch nach der teglichen prefation gesatzt, oder deudsch Esaia dem propheten das geschach, wie es im gesangbüchlin stehet. So man zeit hat, mag der priester auch eine vermanung und unterricht vom hochwirdigen sacrament dem volk furlesen. Wie auch nach den prefationibus verzeichnet. Nach der vermanung, oder wenn um kurz der zeit willen, die vermanung und prefation unterlassen werden, alsbald nach der predigt singe der priester

If then the time permit, the priest may sing the Preface, in German or in Latin, beginning with these words: *Dominus vobiscum*, or "The Lord be with you". And thou findest the Prefaces also set down together hereafter in their place with the customary notes. Thereupon the Sanctus is sung in Latin, as it is also set after the daily Preface, or in German, "Isaiah the prophet, it befell", as it standeth in the song-book. If there be time, the priest may also read to the people an exhortation and instruction concerning the most worthy sacrament, as is also set down after the Prefaces. After the exhortation, or, when for shortness of time the exhortation and Preface are left out, straightway after the sermon, let the priest sing [the Our Father and the Words of the Testament].

### 2.10.2 Where the Sanctus fell

**Five places.** The Sanctus is the ordinary that moved most:

1. **After the Preface, before the Verba** (the Roman place): Mecklenburg 1552, Pomerania 1535, Brandenburg 1540, the Palatinate 1546, Transylvania 1547.

2. **After the Verba**, which were sung in the Preface: the *Formula missae* ("with the elevation during the Benedictus") and Prussia 1525 (§2.4.4).
3. **After the Verba, without a Preface**: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, followed by the Lord's Prayer and the Pax (§2.4.3).
4. **During the distribution**, in German: the *Deutsche Messe*, Duke Henry's Saxony 1539, Albertine Saxony 1580, Mecklenburg 1552 (as an alternative), Hof 1592 (the Latin Sanctus and Agnus "of the season" sung during the communion), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 ("at another time, or at all times, under the communion").
5. **Nowhere**: Württemberg and the Reformed orders.

#### 2.10.3 With or without the Benedictus

**The Latin Sanctus kept its Benedictus.** Where the Latin Sanctus was sung, it was sung whole, with the *Benedictus qui venit* and its *Hosanna*. The *Formula missae* had the elevation "under the singing of the *Benedictus*" (Sehling 1, p. 6). The Palatinate order of 1546 has the choir sing "the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei", that is, through the *Benedictus* (Sehling 14, p. 97), and the Amberg hospital church in 1544 "the Sanctus as far as the Agnus Dei" before the German Lord's Prayer (Sehling 13, p. 283).

**Luther's German Sanctus dropped it.** "Jesaia dem Propheten" paraphrases Isaiah 6 only, and so has no *Benedictus* and no *Hosanna*. Where it replaced the Latin Sanctus, the *Benedictus* went with it.

**The other German Sanctus kept it.** The prose German Sanctus of the early German Masses, and the Trinitarian Sanctus of Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, keep the *Benedictus* and the Hebrew *Hosianna*:

- Kantz (Nördlingen 1522): "Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Sabaoth; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest!" (Sehling 12, p. 286), with *Hosanna* rendered *Glück und heil*;
- Bremen 1525, in Low German, the same (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 406);
- Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: "Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost … *Hosianna* in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. *Hosianna* in the highest" (Sehling 6/1, p. 59);
- Dortmund 1554, Low German, with the gloss "*Hosianna* (ah, make us blessed)" (Sehling 21, p. 211);
- the Neuenrade order of 1564 prints two Low German Sanctus texts, both with "*Gelovet sy, de da kümt im namen des Heren*" (Sehling 22, p. 532);
- Volprecht and Döber at Nürnberg (1524–1525) rendered *Hosanna* "*Mach uns selig in der höhe*", "make us blessed in the highest" (Sehling 11, pp. 41, 54; Chapter 7, §§7.7–7.8).

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### 2.11 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution

The Words of Institution, their wording, their chant and the elevation are treated order by order in Chapter 7; the people's Lord's Prayer hymn in Chapter 8, §8.13. This section compares their order.

**Seven sequences.**

| Sequence | Orders |
|---|---|
| Preface with Verba → Sanctus → Lord's Prayer → Pax → communion | *Formula missae* 1523; Prussia 1525 (with the Agnus before the Pax) |
| Exhortation → Verba → Sanctus → Lord's Prayer → Pax → communion | Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 |
| Preface → Sanctus → Verba → Lord's Prayer → Pax → Agnus → exhortation → communion | Brandenburg 1540 |
| (Preface → Sanctus →) Lord's Prayer → Verba → communion | Wittenberg 1533; Pomerania 1535; Mecklenburg 1552; Transylvania 1547; Palatinate 1546 (Verba → Pax); Hof 1592 (Lord's Prayer → Pax → Verba) |
| Paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer + exhortation → Verba → communion | *Deutsche Messe* 1526; Duke Henry's Saxony 1539; Albertine Saxony 1580; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (at times) |

| Sequence | Orders |
|---|---|
| Lord's Prayer hymn → confession → Verba read → communion | Württemberg 1553 |
| Prayer ending in the Lord's Prayer → creed → breaking of bread | Palatinate 1563; Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (both Reformed) |

**The bread and the cup apart.** The *Deutsche Messe* gave the bread after the words over the bread and the cup after the words over the cup. Albertine Saxony (1580) required this "in the villages, where this sacrament is given out by one person only" (Sehling 1, p. 369), and Prussia (1544) followed it (Sehling 4, pp. 65–66). Elsewhere both words were said or sung before the distribution.

**The elevation.** Kept with the Verba in the *Formula missae*, Prussia 1525, Wittenberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540 and Breslau 1557; abolished in the Palatinate 1546 and in Mecklenburg 1552, "that the inequality bring not contention" (Sehling 5, p. 199). See Chapter 7 and Chapter 12, §12.10.6.

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## 2.12 The Agnus Dei

The German Agnus hymns ("Christe du Lamm Gottes", "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig") and their place after the communion are in Chapter 8, §§8.14–8.15.

### 2.12.1 How many times

**Three, as of old.** The Latin Agnus Dei three times, the third ending *dona nobis pacem*, is printed in full in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and Brandenburg 1540 (Sehling 13, p. 75; 3, p. 69). Regensburg had the schoolmaster sing it "three times slowly" during the distribution, and more songs if the three were not enough (1542 and 1553: Sehling 13, pp. 393, 420). Luther's German "Christe du Lamm Gottes" kept the threefold form: "*Christe, du lamb gottes … erbarm dich unser*. The third time thus: *gib uns deinen friden, amen*" (Wittenberg 1533, Sehling 1, p. 705). Hamburg (1529) and Neuenrade (1564) say the same in Low German (Sehling 5, p. 529; 22, p. 532). Hof sang "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" three times, "the last time with these words added: *Gib uns dein fride, o Jesu*" (Sehling 11, p. 429). Müntzer's Allstedt (Radical Reformation) order had the people sing the Baptist's witness "three times", the third ending "Give us thy peace" (Sehling 1, p. 506).

**Twice.** The Prussian order of 1525 cut the Agnus Dei to two, "for brevity's sake", so that the people's hymns during the communion should have more room. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Bald darauf singet der chor das agnus dei, mit wenig noten deütsch oder lateinisch nach gelegenheit, doch von kürz wegen allein zweimal, damit die nachfolgenden christlichen gesenge der gemeine so vil bas stad haben, und das erste mahel mit dem miserere nobis, zum andern mit dem dona nobis pacem zubeschliessen.

Straightway thereupon the choir singeth the Agnus Dei with few notes, in German or Latin as occasion serveth, yet for brevity's sake only twice, that the Christian songs of the congregation following may have the more room; and to conclude the first time with the *miserere nobis*, the second with the *dona nobis pacem*.

The Livonian towns copied it: "the Agnus Dei with few notes, twice … first, *Be gracious to us*; second, *Give us thy peace*" (Wolmar 1533, Sehling 5, p. 16).

**Once.** The Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545 had the choir sing the Latin Agnus Dei once, after the communion, while the people knelt and gave thanks. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 301):

> so sol der chor anheben, das lateinische agnus dei nur ein mal singen, in des kniet das volk und thut seine danksagung zu got.

then shall the choir begin to sing the Latin Agnus Dei only once; meanwhile the people kneel and make their thanksgiving to God.

The single German strophe "Christe du Lamm Gottes … erbarm dich unser. Gib uns deinen Frieden", printed once as the close of the communion, is the form of Duke Henry's Saxony (1539) and the Calenberg-Göttingen Masses (1542) (Sehling 1, p. 275; 6/2,

pp. 819, 824), and Kantz's Mass of 1522 has one strophe combining both endings (Sehling 12, p. 286).

#### 2.12.2 Where it fell

**Before or during the communion.** In the Roman place, before the communion, in Prussia 1525 and Brandenburg 1540; during the distribution in the *Formula missae*, Nürnberg 1533, Pomerania 1535, Mecklenburg 1552, Transylvania 1547, Albertine Saxony 1580 and Hof 1592.

**After the communion.** The German Agnus "Christe du Lamm Gottes" after the communion as its close in Wittenberg 1533 ("when the communion is ended"), Hamburg 1529 ("when they have all communicated and are in their places"), Pomerania 1535 and Mecklenburg 1552. Pomerania limits the Latin Agnus and the hymns during the communion: "but not longer than the communion lasteth" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

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## 2.13 The dismissal and the blessing

The Roman Mass ended with *Ite missa est* (or *Benedicamus Domino* in Masses without the Gloria), and then the priest's blessing, *Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus, Pater et Filius et Spiritus Sanctus*, a Trinitarian blessing (Sehling 11, p. 42, note 21). The evangelical orders changed both. The *Benedicamus* in the offices, its seasonal melodies and its German forms are treated in Chapter 8, §§8.16.8–8.16.10; the closing hymns in §8.15 of the same chapter.

#### 2.13.1 *Ite missa est*, *Benedicamus*, or neither

**Three practices.** A search of every *Ite missa est* and every *Benedicamus* near the end of the Mass gives three practices:

- **The *Ite* kept.** Only two places:
  - the Breslau report of 1557: "with the *Benedicamus* or *Ite missa est* the Mass is closed" (Sehling 3, p. 404);
  - the Brandenburg-Ansbach visitation of 1536, which kept the old order "from the *Confiteor* to the end of the Mass, *Ite missa est*", so far as it was not against Scripture (Sehling 11, p. 326). The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, then put "the *Benedicamus* for the *Ite missa*" (Sehling 11, p. 327).
- **The *Benedicamus* in its place**, in Latin or in German (lists below).
- **Neither.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* and most Saxon, Bugenhagen, Upper German and Reformed orders end with the thanksgiving collect and the blessing, and at most a hymn after it. Pomerania (1535): "after the Amen nothing more is sung" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

**Never *Ite missa est*.** Volprecht's Nürnberg Mass makes the rule explicit. **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the Prior Volprecht, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 39):

> Benechctio: ista dicitur et nunquam dicitur Ite missa est; loco ejus dicitur Benedicamus Domino Responsio: Deo gratias.

The blessing: this is said, and never is *Ite missa est* said; in its place is said *Benedicamus Domino*; response: *Deo gratias*.

**The Latin *Benedicamus*:**

- Luther, *Formula missae* (1523): in the place of the *Ite*, "with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth)", or with the vesper melodies (§2.3.2; Sehling 1, p. 6);
- Nürnberg, *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe* (1525): "*Benedicamus Domino*, *dominicaliter*", then "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (Sehling 11, p. 57);
- Goslar (1528): the collect "with the *Benedicamus*" sung by the boys in the choir after the distribution (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 242);
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533), followed by the blessing (quoted below, Sehling 11, p. 198);
- Regensburg (1542): the gospeller sings *Deo dicamus gratias*; Regensburg (1553): the second minister sings *Benedicamus Domino*, the choir *Deo dicamus gratias* (Sehling 13, pp. 393, 421);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543): sung by the priest or the deacons "in the tone in which the Kyrie was sung", the choir answering in the same tone *Deo dicamus gratias* (Sehling 13, p. 76);
- Transylvania (1547): *Dominus vobiscum*, collect and *Benedicamus*, all concluded "with the blessing of the people in the name of the Holy Trinity" (Sehling 24, pp. 223, 244);

- Hohenlohe (1553): "the collect with *Benedicamus Domino*", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 15, p. 73); the Öhringen foundation (1556) prints its melody with the Mass (Sehling 15, p. 104);
- Suhl in Henneberg (1562): "Collect. *Benedicamus*. The blessing out of Moses" (Sehling 2, p. 351);
- Wolfstein (1574): "the thanksgiving, the *Benedicamus*, the choir answereth *Deo gratias*, and the blessing" (Sehling 13, p. 577);
- Chemnitz (1578): "the collect which is called the *complenda*, and the *Benedicamus* together with the benediction, as is customary" (Sehling 1, p. 542).

**The German *Benedicamus*.** The early German Masses put the versicle into German, and Hof kept it with its own melody in 1592:

- Müntzer, Allstedt (1524, Radical Reformation): each German Mass ends with a prayer and the *Benedicamus*, "Last uns gesegnen den herren, alleluia. Got sei ewiglich dank" (Sehling 1, pp. 497, 502);
- Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525), after Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "Lasst uns gesegnen den herren. Gott sei ewiglich dank", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 2, p. 380);
- Lippe (1525), in Low German: "Ladt uns benedyen den hern, Gade sy ewich danck", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 22, p. 569);
- Volprecht's German Mass (1524), after the blessing: "Last uns den Herrn lob und dank sagen! Antwort: Gott sei gedankt" (Sehling 11, p. 42);
- Worms (1524, Moderate Reformed): "Last uns gott gebenedeien", then a Trinitarian blessing (quoted below);
- Strasbourg (1524, Moderate Reformed): "Sagen danck dem herren", then the blessing (Sehling 20/1, pp. 133, 139);
- Hof (1592): the deacon "addeth the German *Benedicamus*": "Last uns gebenedeien den Herren. Chorus: Gott sei gedankt", then the Aaronic blessing (Sehling 11, pp. 426–427).

**Before or after the blessing.** In most orders that kept it the *Benedicamus* came before the blessing, as in the Roman Mass. Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1528 put it after: "for the conclusion the benediction of Numbers 6 in German, thereafter *Benedicamus Domino* sung" (Sehling 11, p. 137). So did Volprecht's German Mass, and Nürnberg 1525, where the *Benedicamus* is followed by a hymn.

#### 2.13.2 The blessing: Aaronic, Trinitarian, or both

**Five practices.** The blessings at the end of the Mass were searched in every form: Numbers 6, Psalm 67, the Trinitarian formulas ("Gott Vater, Sohn und heiliger Geist", *Benedicat vos … Pater et Filius*), and 2 Corinthians 13:13. They give five practices:

- **The Aaronic blessing alone.** This is the rule, from the *Formula missae* onward. It is in the singular ("Der Herr segne dich") in the *Deutsche Messe* and the Saxon orders, and in the plural ("Der Herr gesegen euch") in Nürnberg and the south. Examples:
  - Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526);
  - Wittenberg (1533);
  - Pomerania (1535);
  - Mecklenburg (1552);
  - Albertine Saxony (1580);
  - Volprecht (1524) and Döber (1525) at Nürnberg;
  - Lippe and Erfurt (1525);
  - Weißenburg and Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1528);
  - Hohenlohe (1553);
  - Suhl (1562);
  - Hof (1592);
  - the Palatinate's Sunday service (1563, Reformed, Sehling 14, p. 391).
- **A Trinitarian blessing alone**: the early German Masses of Worms and Strasbourg (1524, both Moderate Reformed), and Regensburg (1542), all quoted below. Transylvania (1547) blesses "in the name of the Holy Trinity" without printing the words (Sehling 24, p. 223).
- **The Aaronic and the Trinitarian together**, the second following the first: Strasbourg's *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess* (1524, Moderate Reformed): "Gesegne euch der herr … Der segen Got, des vatters und des suns etc." (Sehling 20/1, p. 140); and the Strasbourg Supper of 1598 (quoted below).

- **A choice of forms**: the Brandenburg-Nürnberg set of four, and its descendants (below).
- **Different blessings for different occasions**: Prussia (1525) and Strasbourg (1598) (below).

**The Nürnberg set of four.** Brandenburg-Nürnberg gave four blessings to choose from: Numbers 6; a paraphrase of Psalm 67; and two Trinitarian forms. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 198):

> Benedicamus Domino. Deo gracias. Darnach segne er das volk also: Der Herr gesegen euch und behüte euch! Der Herr erleuchte sein angesicht über euch und sei euch gnedig! Der Herr erhebe sein angesicht auf euch und gebe euch fride! Amen. Oder also: Gott sei uns gnedig und barmherzig und gebe uns seinen götlichen segen! Er laß uns sein angesicht leuchten und gebe uns seinen frid! Amen. Oder also: Gesegen und behüte uns, Gott der Vater und der Sune und der Heilig Gaist! Amen. Oder also: Der segen Gott des Vaters und des Suns und des Heiligen Gaists sei mit euch und bleib allezeit mit uns allen! Amen.

*Benedicamus Domino. Deo gratias.* Thereafter let him bless the people thus: "The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! Amen." Or thus: "God be gracious and merciful unto us and give us his divine blessing! May he cause his face to shine upon us and give us his peace! Amen." Or thus: "Bless and keep us, God the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost! Amen." Or thus: "The blessing of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost be with you and abide alway with us all! Amen."

The set passed, whole or shortened, into these orders:

| Order | Sehling | Forms offered |
|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 | 11, p. 198 | Aaronic; Ps 67; "Gesegne und behüte uns, Gott der Vater …"; "Der Segen Gottes des Vaters …" |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 | 13, p. 76 | the same four |
| Schwäbisch Hall 1543 | 17/1, p. 135 | Aaronic; the two Trinitarian forms |
| Strasbourg 1553 (Marbach) | 20/1, p. 415 | the same four |
| Württemberg 1553 | 16, p. 255 | Aaronic (singular); Ps 67; "Gesegne und behüte uns, Gott …" |
| Kurpfalz 1556 | 14, p. 150 | as Württemberg, in the plural |
| Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560 | 19/1, p. 210 | the same four |
| Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 | 19/1, p. 253 | Aaronic; Ps 67; "Gesegne und behüte uns, Gott …" |
| Regensburg 1567 | 13, p. 463 | Aaronic (singular), or "Es segne und behüte euch Gott der Vater, Gott der Son und Gott der Heilig Geist" |
| Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573 | 20/2, p. 67 | Aaronic; Ps 67; "Gesegne und behüte uns, Gott …" |
| Oldenburg 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1145 | Aaronic (singular); Ps 67; the two Trinitarian forms |
| Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; Lützelstein 1605 | 18, pp. 504, 607 | Aaronic with "Gehet hin, der Geist des Herrn geleite euch zum ewigen Leben", or "Der Segen Gottes, des Vaters und des Sohns und des heiligen Geistes … und sein heiliger Geist stärke und erhalte uns zum ewigen Leben" |

**A Trinitarian blessing alone.** The first German Mass of Worms (Moderate Reformed) closed with a German *Benedicamus* and the Trinitarian blessing only. **Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 129):

> Last uns gott gebenedeien. Danck, lob, ere unnd preiß sei gott durch Christum, unsern herren, Amen. Benedictio: Der segen des Almechtigen gottes, vatters, suns und heyligen geyst, sei mit euch und bleib alweg bei euch. Amen.

Let us bless God. Thanks, laud, honour and praise be to God through Christ our Lord, Amen. The blessing: "The blessing of Almighty God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost, be with you and abide alway with you. Amen."

The Nunc dimittis followed. The two Strasbourg Masses of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) by Theobald Schwarz and in the *Teutsche Meß und Tauff* end the same way: "Der segen Gott, des vatters [+] und des suns [+] und des heiligen geists [+], sey mit uns und bleib alweg", with three signs of the cross (Sehling 20/1, pp. 123, 133). At Regensburg in 1542 the priest blessed with the Trinitarian form alone. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, p. 393):

> Darnach kert sich der priester umb gegen dem volk und segnet dasselbig mit disen worten: Es gesegne und behüte uns Gott der Vater, Sone und Heiliger Geist. Amen

Thereafter the priest turneth about toward the people and blesseth them with these words: "Bless and keep us God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen."

**By occasion: feasts and weekdays.** Prussia assigned a sung blessing from Psalm 67 to the feasts, and the Aaronic blessing to ordinary days, at the end of matins, vespers and the Mass alike. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, pp. 37–38):

> Volgen die benediction oder beschluss gesang am encl der metten, vesper und mess. Diebus Festivis. Es wol uns gott seinen segen geben, unser got segen uns. [p. 38] […] Responsio. Und es sollen ihn ferchten alle ende der welt amen. Quotitiana benedictio. Der herr erleuchte sein angesicht über uns und sei uns gnedig

There follow the benediction or closing chant at the end of matins, vespers and Mass. On feast days: "God give us his blessing, our God bless us." Response: "And all the ends of the world shall fear him, Amen." The daily benediction: "The Lord make his face shine upon us and be gracious unto us."

**By occasion: the sermon and the Supper.** Strasbourg in 1598 closed the plain preaching service with the Trinitarian blessing alone, "Die Benedeiung Gottes, des Vatters, des Sohns und des heiligen Geistes, seie jetzt und zu allen zeiten mit uns allen" (Sehling 20/1, p. 589). It closed the Supper with the Aaronic and the Trinitarian together. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 613):

> Der Herr segne Euch und behüte Euch. Der Herr laß sein Angesicht leuchten uber Euch und sei Euch gnädig. Der Herr hebe sein Angesicht uber Euch und geb Euch den Frieden. Die Benedeihung Gottes, des Vaters, des Sohns und des heil. Geistes, seie jetzt und zu allen zeiten mit uns allen, Amen. Gehet hin im Frieden des Herren

"The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace. The benediction of God, of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, be now and at all times with us all, Amen." Go hence in the peace of the Lord.

**2 Corinthians 13:13.** The apostolic blessing, "Die gnad unsers Herrn Jesu Christi und die liebe Gottes, sampt der gemeinschaft des heiligen Geistes", appears in two places:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) gives it as the alternative to Numbers 6 when the minister dismisses the congregation (Sehling 8, p. 248);
- Nördlingen (1579) closes the pulpit prayers with it (Sehling 12, p. 368).

**Psalm 67** stands beside the blessing in three forms:

- Luther's third option in the *Formula missae*;
- the second form of the Nürnberg set;
- the sung feast-day blessing of Prussia.

Where it was sung as Luther's hymn, "Es wolle uns Gott genädig sein", it closed the service after the blessing: Nürnberg 1525 (Sehling 11, p. 57), Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 147), and Hoya 1571, in a service without the Supper (Sehling 6/2, p. 1152; Chapter 8, §8.15).

**After the blessing.**

- Pomerania (1535) ended there (Sehling 4, p. 341).

- Mecklenburg (1552) added "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" or "Verleih uns Frieden" (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- Duke Henry's Saxony (1539) added "Gott sei gelobet", "and so go home" (Sehling 1, p. 275).

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## 2.14 When nobody communicated

**The Mass without the Supper.** No evangelical order allowed a Mass without communicants. When nobody had announced himself for the Supper, the Mass stopped after the sermon. What was left was the first half of the ordo, closed with prayers. The postcommunion substitutes and the Litany in this place are treated in Chapter 5, §5.6, and Chapter 13, §13.22; the change of vestments in Chapter 14, §14.7.

**The forms.**

- **Pomerania 1535**: "everything is sung, as is ordered, until the sermon; but after the sermon one or two German psalms" (Sehling 4, p. 341).
- **Mecklenburg 1552**: confession and absolution; a German psalm or two, or "Allein Gott"; collect; epistle; psalm; gospel; *Patrem*; "Wir glauben"; the sermon with the prayer (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: "after the sermon, or a chapter of holy Scripture read, it shall be concluded with a Christian collect and the customary benediction" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Transylvania 1547**: no Mass, but a German psalm, collect, sequence or tract, a chapter of the New Testament in course, "Wir glauben", and the suffrages.

The Transylvanian rubric shows how far the service fell back toward the office. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 244):

> Wo aber zu diesem ampt keine communicanten vorhanden sein, wird keine meß nit gehalten, sonder an stat singt man zum ersten einen Deutschen psalmen, darauff die collect, meer ein Christliche sequentz oder tract oder was die zeit mit bringt. Darnach wird gelesen vom anfang des newen testaments biß zum ende nach der ordnung allweg ein Deutsch capitel, allein das man in der fasten die Deutsch episteln und evangelien behelt, wie sie nach den tagen verordnet sein. Nach der lection desselbigen capitels singt man: Wir gleuben all, mit dem versikel und collecten von der heiligen Dreifeltigkeit. Darnach folgen auch die andere suffragia, nemlich für den könig, umb vergebung der sunden und umb frieden mit iren versikeln und collecten, welches auch mit dem Benedicamus und segen des volcks beschlossen wirdt.

But where there are no communicants for this office, no Mass at all is held; but in its stead there is sung first a German psalm, thereupon the collect, further a Christian sequence or tract, or what the season bringeth. Thereafter is read, in order from the beginning of the New Testament to the end, always one chapter in German; only that in Lent the German epistles and gospels are kept, as they are appointed for the days. After the reading of the same chapter is sung "We all believe", with the versicle and collect of the Holy Trinity. Thereafter follow also the other suffrages, namely for the king, for the forgiveness of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects; which also is concluded with the *Benedicamus* and the blessing of the people.

**The boys' daily Mass at Hof.** One order kept a Mass-shaped service with no communion at all, as a school exercise. At Hof (1592) the boys' "*actus diurnus*" ran: the seasonal Kyrie and *Et in terra* from the great missal; the gospel in Latin; sequence, tract or gradual; the gospel in German; "the Sanctus of the season", with the Preface on the chief feasts; the Lord's Prayer sung by a boy "in the deacon's place"; "the Agnus Dei of the season"; and a collect (Sehling 11, pp. 472–473).

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## 2.15 Ceremonial: gestures, postures and places

Several gestures are treated elsewhere:

- where the minister stands, and whether he faces the people: Chapter 14, §14.5.2;
- vestments: Chapter 14, §14.7;
- the elevation, the signs of the cross printed over the elements, and the bows of the Latin-frame canons: Chapter 7 (e.g. §§7.12.3, 7.12.8);
- the priest kneeling at the preparation and after the Mass: Chapter 3, §§3.3.2–3.3.4, 3.6.3;
- kneeling during *Veni sancte Spiritus*, "Nun bitten wir" and the hymn in the place of the offertory: Chapter 8, §§8.4.1, 8.11.3, 8.13.2;

- deacons, subdeacons and ministrants at the altar: Chapter 16, §16.4.2.

This section gathers what the orders prescribe for the body during the Mass, gesture by gesture.

### 2.15.1 What the orders say, and what they do not

**The searches.** The corpus was searched, near the Mass and the Supper, for each of the following:

- the sign of the cross ("creutz machen", *signum crucis*, "segnen", and the † and [+] marks the editions print in the text);
- genuflection (*genuflexio*, "kniebeugen", *flexis genibus*);
- kneeling, bowing (*inclinatio*, "neigen", "bücken") and standing or sitting;
- hats and bare heads ("hut", "baret", *capite aperto*, "bloßes haupt");
- the hands (*manibus iunctis*, *extensis*, "gefaltene hände", "aufgehobene hände");
- turning ("kert sich zum volk", *conversus ad populum*), the sides and horns of the altar (*cornu*, "rechte seite", "epistelseite");
- the kiss and the pax, incense and the washing of hands.

**Few rubrics.** The orders prescribe little. Where they say anything, it is usually one of three things:

- kneeling, for prayer and for communion;
- turning, toward the altar to pray and toward the people to read, greet and exhort;
- a warning against the old gestures.

Much was left to custom. Nassau (1575, Philippist) keeps "the customary old form of the administration" of the Supper, but drops the "rites and gesticulations" (Sehling 10, p. 151).

**Not found.** No order in the corpus prescribes any of the following:

- the Roman genuflection on one knee. *Flexis genibus* and "mit gebogenen knien" always mean kneeling;
- the epistle and gospel horns of the altar, or carrying the book from one side to the other;
- turning over the right shoulder, or any rule for the direction of a turn;
- the hands of the celebrant joined, raised in the *orans* position, or extended toward the people;
- the kiss of the altar, of the book, of the paten, or of the deacon's hand. Nor are there any honours paid to the deacon;
- the celebrant's biretta, or taking it off and putting it on at the altar;
- incense at the Mass;
- the *Lavabo*.

### 2.15.2 The sign of the cross

**Kept in the early German Masses.** The first German Masses still print the crosses:

- **Allstedt** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts* (1523) marks the bread and the cup at the Words of Institution: "gesegnete † das und brach es", "gesegnete † den". The minister raises his hand at "Das ist mein leichnam" (*Elevando manu*), and turns to the people with the cup (Sehling 1, p. 506).
- **Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). In Schwarz's German Mass of 1524 the places "where the cross is to be made" are marked [+], according to the editors (Sehling 20/1, p. 120). The priest, turned to the people, says "Gott begnade unnd erbarme sich uber uns alle [+]" at the beginning. He blesses with three crosses at the end, "Der segen Gott, des vatters [+] und des suns [+] und des heiligen geists [+]" (Sehling 20/1, pp. 120, 123). The *Teutsche Meß und Tauff* and the *Ordenung und inhalt* of 1524 do the same (pp. 130, 133, 137).
- **Hof.** As late as 1592 the order prints a † after the deacon's Pax, "Der frid des Herren sei mit euch allen. †", and after the blessing (Sehling 11, pp. 426–427).

The Latin-frame orders keep the signs over the elements at the Verba. They are printed in Chapter 7 with ✠.

**Rejected.** Hannover (1536) lets go of what is not needful, among it "so many crosses" and "such gestures" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1007–1008). Danzig (1557), as Sehling quotes it, makes the point at the Words of Institution. **Danzig, first order of the Sunday Mass, 1557** (Sehling 4, p. 168):

> nimpt der priester die paten mit der geordenten hostien in die hand ohn alles papistisches creuzigen und andere geberde, also auch, wenn er die worte singt: nam er den kelch, nimmt er den kelch in die hand

The priest taketh the paten with the appointed host into his hand without all papistical crossing and other gestures; so also, when he singeth the words "he took the cup", he taketh the cup into his hand.

**Outside the Mass.** The sign of the cross stayed in baptism, at the exorcism ("Nim das zeichen des heiligen creutzs", Luther's *Taufbüchlein*, Sehling 1, p. 18). It also stayed in the household prayers of the Small Catechism: "In the morning … thou shalt bless thyself with the holy cross and say: The will of God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost be done" (Kurpfalz 1556, Sehling 14, p. 141).

### 2.15.3 Kneeling, not genuflecting

**The priest kneels.** The priest kneels at these points:

- for his preparation or *Confiteor* at the foot of the altar (Pfalz-Neuburg, Mecklenburg, Regensburg, Hildesheim and others; Chapter 3, §§3.3.2–3.3.4). At Solms (1603) he does so "on the stool" before the altar (Sehling 9, p. 359);
- for the Kyrie and the prayers at Schwäbisch Hall (1535, below);
- through "Nun bitten wir" at Soest (1609), where the pastor "remains sitting on his knees" (Sehling 22, p. 489);
- after communion. At Hildesheim (1544) he kneels again before the altar and "thanketh God secretly for himself" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855). In Mecklenburg (1540/1545) the priest kneels before the altar and "the whole congregation shall do likewise", and they sing "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" (Sehling 5, p. 155).

**The congregation kneels.** The Brenz order for Schwäbisch Hall makes the whole church kneel at the Kyrie, and says why. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 49):

> Nach dem psalmen sol gesungen werden das Kirieleyson wie vor gewonhait, doch dieweyl es ein ernstlich, diemutig gebet ist, sol die gantz kirch darzu knien, nit das es etwas gegen got an dem knien lieg, sonder das doch in der kirchen ein gemein Zucht sey und ein igklichs sein ordnung

After the psalm the Kyrie eleison shall be sung, as hath been customary. But since it is an earnest, humble prayer, the whole church shall kneel thereto; not that anything toward God lieth in the kneeling, but that there may be a common discipline in the church, and every thing its order.

The Hall draft of 1535 kneels everyone for the Lord's Prayer before the Verba, and lets the pastor alone stand up to say them. **Schwäbisch Hall, draft order of service, 1535** (Sehling 17/1, p. 102):

> Am ende der Annunctiation soll beschlossen werden mit eim Vatter unser, das bette yederman heimlich, auch nider kniend. Nach dem gebett steht der pfarrer allain auff und spreche die wort Consecrationis: Dan in der nacht, do der HERR etc. uberlaut, teutsch

At the end of the announcement it shall be concluded with an Our Father, which every man shall pray secretly, kneeling down also. After the prayer the pastor alone standeth up and saith the words of consecration, "For in the night in which the LORD," etc., aloud, in German.

Other orders kneel the congregation at these points:

- from the Lord's Prayer to the end of the communion: Hatzkerode (1534): "the whole church shall kneel devoutly until the end of the communion" (Sehling 2, p. 587);
- at the Lord's Prayer of the preparation for the Supper, after the examination and the declaration of forgiveness: the Palatinate (1563, Reformed): "Kniet nider und betet, wie uns der herr gelehret hat: Unser vater" (Sehling 14, p. 383). The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) copied the preparation but struck the kneeling out ("Getilgt ist das Knien beim Gebet", Sehling 14, p. 574);
- at the thanksgiving: Heilbronn (1543): "Knieend nieder und hebt ewere hertzen zu gott" (Sehling 17/1, p. 316); Lützelstein (1605): "Kniet und thut die Dancksagung" (Sehling 18, p. 606);
- at the prayers: in the penitential service of Wittgenstein (1555) the ministers kneel and bid the people "also sit upon their knees" (Sehling 22, p. 139); Ulm (1556): the preachers asked that the people, who sat through the common prayer "out of the convenience of the pews", be taught to kneel, "as is customary in other churches" (Sehling 17/2, p. 213);

- in the place of the offertory: Celle (1545) and Anhalt (1548) (Chapter 8, §8.11.3).

**Boys kneeling before the altar.** The singers of certain pieces knelt:

- *Da pacem*, three times, in the Pomeranian Mass (1569, Sehling 4, p. 438);
- "Kom, heiliger Geist" at Corvey's Bruchhausen (1603, Sehling 21, p. 244);
- the litany at Marggrabowa in Prussia (1581, Sehling 4, p. 149);
- *Veni sancte Spiritus* and "Nun bitten wir" at Hof, with the whole choir kneeling (Chapter 8, §8.4.1).

**At "and was made man".** One custom is reported only later. At Mansfeld, as a memorial against the Flacian error of Cyriacus Spangenberg, four choirboys knelt before the altar during the Creed. They sang alone "ist ein wahrer Mensch geboren" and touched the altar steps with their foreheads; the custom lasted into the eighteenth century (Sehling 2, p. 183, after Leopold's chronicle of 1817).

**Communicants kneel.** Most orders that say how communion was received have the communicants kneel at the altar:

- Regensburg (1542): the men on the right of the altar, the women on the left, "that at the end of the *Patrem* they kneel down there" (Sehling 13, pp. 392–393);
- Hohenlohe (1553): two honourable men set out a silk cloth and "little benches, on which the communicants kneel" (Sehling 15, p. 71);
- Lippe (1566): the men on one side, the women on the other (Sehling 21, p. 388);
- Marienhafe in East Frisia (1593): "kneeling, at one end of the altar or table the blessed bread, at the other the cup" (Sehling 7/1, p. 710);
- Solms (1603): the communicants kneel in the choir while the pastor, turned toward them, reads the exhortation (Sehling 9, p. 361);
- Ermsleben (1564): "they kneel down devoutly; then I pray before them, and they pray after me secretly; thereafter I do the consecration" (Sehling 2, p. 485).

After receiving, the communicants in Bugenhagen's orders went back to their places and "sit on their knees or stand, until the last blessing" (Hamburg 1529, Sehling 5, p. 529; Wolfenbüttel 1543, Sehling 6/1, p. 58).

**Standing allowed, sitting forbidden.** In Poland the Lutheran, Reformed and Brethren churches of the Sandomierz consensus had to settle the posture together. **Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578** (Sandomierz consensus; Sehling 4, p. 263):

> ceremonias libertati christianae donamns, ac permittimus, ut stantes vel genua flectentes pii sacramentum corporis et sanguinis Christi sumant. Sessionis vero ad mensam domini, quia, praeter ritus in omnibus per Europam evangelicis ecclesiis vulgo consuetos, illi inter nos primi autores extiterunt, qui […] a nobis ad arrianismum perfidi transfugae facti sunt […] ceremoniam rejicimus

We grant the ceremonies to Christian liberty, and permit that the godly receive the sacrament of the body and blood of Christ standing or kneeling. But the sitting at the Lord's table, since, besides the rites commonly used in all evangelical churches throughout Europe, those were the first authors of it among us who […] became faithless deserters from us to Arianism […] we reject as a ceremony.

The synod of 1583 repeated the rule. Communion was to be given "to those standing or kneeling (with a protestation against the bread-worship customary among the papists)" (Sehling 4, p. 264). The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) received kneeling. Their *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, as Sehling prints it, explains that their forebears had brought in standing in 1494 and gave it up under persecution (Sehling 4, p. 284). In Reformed Emden a Lasco still received kneeling over a towel; the custom was abolished by 1546 at the latest (editors' note, Sehling 7/1, p. 377).

**Reverence, not adoration.** The Calvinizing Nassau order of 1575 (Philippist) warned the people off the old gestures. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 151):

> Darbeneben soll man das vo[l]ck abmanen, das sie woll zuchtig und ehrerbietig, aber nicht als mit gefaltenen henden unnd kniebauw einen abgott (wie im bapstum geschicht und etliche der unsern noch gewohnet seint) anbetten wollen, ertzeigen sollen. Nach verlessener vermanung: Ir allerliebsten in Gott etc., sollen die kirchendiener also mit zugewentem angesicht zum volck stehen pleiben

Moreover the people shall be exhorted that they show themselves modest and reverent indeed, but not as though they would worship an idol with folded hands and bending of the knee (as is done in the papacy, and some of ours are still wont). After the exhortation "Dearly beloved in God", etc. has been read, the ministers shall remain standing thus with their face turned toward the people.

#### 2.15.4 Bowing

**Only in the Latin canons.** The bows that survive are the priest's, in the orders that kept a Latin canon:

- Brandenburg (1540) lifts the host "with a slight bow" (*Hic modica inclinatione, leva illud reverenter in altum*), and has the priest bow for the ablution prayer *Corpus tuum, Domine* (*Deinde inclinet se et dicat*) (Sehling 3, pp. 69–70);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) copies the second (Sehling 13, p. 76).

The texts are in Chapter 7, §§7.12.3, 7.12.8.

**The name of Jesus.** No order prescribes a bow at the name of Jesus. The words of Philippians 2:10, "Im namen Jesu sollen sich biegen alle knie", are sung as the introit of the Passion Mass by Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and those who copied him (Sehling 1, p. 502; 6/2, p. 825; 2, p. 379), but no rubric turns them into a gesture.

#### 2.15.5 Hats and heads

**Men uncovered, women covered.** Hesse (Moderate Reformed) puts the old rule of 1 Corinthians 11 into the church order. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 231):

> Es gehört auch zum wolstand und christlicher zucht, daß in der gemeinen versamlung der christen die weiber mit bedecktem haupt, die menner aber mit bloßen heuptern erscheinen, davon der apostel Paulus 1. Cor. 11

It belongeth also to seemliness and Christian discipline, that in the common assembly of the Christians the women appear with covered head, but the men with bare heads, whereof the apostle Paul [speaketh], 1 Corinthians 11.

A bare head appears elsewhere as a mark of humility:

- the public penitent at Limpurg (1596) sits through the whole sermon "with bare head" on a stool set before the altar or pulpit (Sehling 16, p. 609);
- at an ordination the superintendent lays his hand "on the bare head" of the new pastor (Württemberg 1559, Sehling 16, p. 356).

No order regulates the clergy's caps at the altar. Clerical caps appear only as dress outside the service (Chapter 14, §14.8).

#### 2.15.6 Hands

**No rule for the celebrant's hands.** The orders say only what the hands hold:

- Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "raising the hand" at the bread (*Elevando manu*), and taking the cup "before the people" (Sehling 1, p. 506);
- Brandenburg (1540): "take the chalice with both hands" (*calicem accipe cum ambabus manibus*) (Sehling 3, p. 69);
- Transylvania (1547): the minister, turned to the people, says the Lord's Prayer and then the Verba "from the book over the bread and the wine, holding each in turn in his hands" (*per vices utrunque tenens in manibus*) (Sehling 24, p. 223).

**Folded hands.** Folded hands appear only for children at the table prayers (Sayn, Solms), and in Nassau's warning against folded hands (1575, Philippist) before the sacrament (above). The laying on of hands belongs to ordination, confirmation, absolution and the reconciliation of penitents, outside the Mass.

#### 2.15.7 Turning: toward the altar, toward the people

**The common rule.** Where the minister stood at an altar against the wall, the orders turn him to the altar to pray and to the people to read, greet and exhort. Wittenberg (1533) sets the pattern: "the priest readeth a German collect turned toward the

altar, and singeth the epistle turned toward the people"; the gospel "turned toward the people", then "again toward the altar" for *Credo in unum Deum* (Sehling 1, p. 704). Other orders follow it:

- Prussia (1544): "the priest turneth to the people and singeth: Der herre sei mit euch, and turneth again to the altar" for the collect (Sehling 4, p. 66);
- Mecklenburg (1552): the collect "toward the altar", then "he turneth himself again toward the people" for the epistle (Sehling 5, p. 202), followed by Lüneburg (1564, Sehling 6/1, p. 553);
- Schwarzburg (1574): the gospel toward the people, the creed toward the altar (Sehling 2, pp. 132–133);
- Osnabrück (1613): the salutation toward the people, the collect and the thanksgiving toward the altar (Sehling 7/1, pp. 268, 270).

**Turned for the Pax.** The minister turns to the people for the Pax:

- Regensburg (1542): "he turneth about toward the people and singeth: *Pax vobiscum*" (Sehling 13, p. 393);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1543): "Darnach wende er sich zum volk" (Sehling 13, p. 75);
- Hof (1592): *Diaconus spectans populum* (Sehling 11, p. 426).

**Turned for the Verba, or away.** The orders divided over the Words of Institution:

- **toward the people:**
  - Müntzer (Radical Reformation; *Vertens se minister … coram vulgo*);
  - Transylvania (*minister conversus ad populum*);
  - Nassau (1575, Philippist, above). Brandenburg (1540) turns to the people for the exhortation and the thanksgiving (*vertens se ad populum*, Sehling 3, pp. 69–70);
- **toward the altar:**
  - Limpurg (1610): "he turneth himself toward the altar and saith with distinct voice the words or institution of the Supper" (Sehling 16, p. 620);
  - Sponheim (1607): the minister is to face the people always, "except when, in the action of the Holy Supper, they speak the words of blessing over the elements standing on the altar and pray the Our Father"; then they turn to the altar. But where the altar allows it, he shall stand behind it and say the whole preface, prayer and consecration there, facing the people (Sehling 18, p. 674).

**Everything toward the people.** Döber's German Mass at the Nürnberg hospital went furthest. **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Andreas Döber, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 51):

> Mit ersten, wenn der priester über altar kumbt und den kelch aus dem sack geton hat, kert er sich zum volk und spricht laut, wie hernach volgt (auch alle wort, die in der ganzen meß sind), so das er doch verstentlich sei den zuhörer

First, when the priest cometh to the altar and hath taken the chalice out of the bag, he turneth himself to the people and speaketh aloud as followeth (also all the words that are in the whole Mass), so that he be understood by the hearers.

Heilbronn's draft of 1532 has the minister standing at the altar "by the cross", not in the Mass vestment, turn to the people to read the German collect (Sehling 17/1, p. 301). Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) has the collect read "after he hath turned himself to the people" (Sehling 8, p. 239). The visitations that rebuilt altars so that the minister should face the people throughout, and the condemnation of standing behind the table, are in Chapter 14, §14.5.2.

### 2.15.8 Places at the altar

**No horns.** The orders do not speak of the epistle and gospel sides. The sides of the altar appear instead as the places of the communicants and of the two elements:

- **Men right, women left.** Regensburg 1542 (above), Wertheim about 1555 (Sehling 11, p. 713), Frankfurt 1530 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 497).
- **Bread at one side, cup at the other.** The orders differ on which side:
  - the Palatinate (1546): the communicants "receive the sacrament of the body of Christ on the left side of the altar, and the sacrament of the blood on the right side" (Sehling 14, p. 97);

  - Hatzkerode (1534) has it the other way round: the body "on the right side from the hand of the pastor", the blood "on the left side from the deacon", with silk cloths held under on both sides (Sehling 2, p. 587);
  - Neckarbischofsheim (1560): the communicants "go round the altar on the right side to the pastor, to receive the blood of the Lord" (Sehling 16, p. 684);
  - Marienhafe 1593: bread at one end, cup at the other (above).
- **At the cross-altar.** Heilbronn (1530): after the creed "the preacher turneth over the cross altar with his two deacons in surplices toward the people" and proclaims the Lord's death (Sehling 17/1, p. 285).

#### 2.15.9 The Peace, the kiss and incense

**The kiss of peace replaced by a reading.** Luther made the Pax an absolution (§2.8). Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) replaced the kiss with a text. **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1542** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 330):

> Deinde, quia apud veteres in distributione coenae dominicae osculum pacis fuit usitatum reconciliationis mutuae signum, legat minister loco illius textum aliquem de reconciliatione fraterna admonendo

Then, since among the ancients at the distribution of the Lord's Supper the kiss of peace was in use as a sign of mutual reconciliation, let the minister in the stead of it read some text of brotherly reconciliation, admonishing [them].

No order keeps a pax-board.

**Incense.** None of the orders prescribes incense at the Mass:

- the *Formula missae* leaves lights and incense at the gospel free (Sehling 1, p. 5);
- Hannover (1536) lets go of "censing" with the other unneeded gestures (Sehling 6/2, p. 1007).

**Ablutions.** In the sick communion of Brandenburg (1540) and Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) the priest rinses his fingers over the chalice and gives the ablution to the sick person (Sehling 3, p. 80; 13, p. 88). The Latin ablution prayers of the Mass are in Chapter 7, §7.12.8.

#### 2.15.10 Summary

| Gesture | Prescribed | Rejected or absent |
|---|---|---|
| Sign of the cross | over bread and cup (Allstedt 1523, Radical Reformation); at the greeting and blessing (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed); at the Pax and blessing (Hof 1592); over the elements in the Latin canons | "so many crosses" let go (Hannover 1536); "without all papistical crossing" (Danzig 1557); "rites and gesticulations" avoided (Nassau 1575, Philippist) |
| Genuflection | none | *flexis genibus* means kneeling |
| Kneeling | priest at the preparation, the Kyrie and after communion; people at the Kyrie (Hall 1527), the Lord's Prayer (Hall 1535, Palatinate 1563 (Reformed)), the whole communion (Hatzkerode 1534), the thanksgiving (Heilbronn 1543, Lützelstein 1605); communicants at the altar; boys at *Da pacem*, the litany, *Veni sancte* | folded hands and kneeling "as to an idol" (Nassau 1575, Philippist); kneeling at prayer struck out (Palatinate 1601, Reformed); sitting at communion forbidden (Petrikau 1578) |
| Bowing | at the elevation and the ablution prayer (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543); boys' foreheads to the step at "Mensch geboren" (Mansfeld, later report) | no bow at the name of Jesus |
| Head | men bareheaded, women covered (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed) | no rubric for the celebrant's cap |
| Hands | raise the hand at the bread (Allstedt, Radical Reformation); the chalice with both hands (Brandenburg); bread and cup held in turn (Transylvania) | no *orans*, joined hands or extended hands |

| Gesture | Prescribed | Rejected or absent |
|---|---|---|
| Turning | to the altar for collects and creed, to the people for readings, salutation, Pax and exhortation (Wittenberg 1533 and most); everything toward the people (Döber 1525) | no direction of turn, no right shoulder |
| Places | men right, women left; bread and cup at two sides or ends | no epistle or gospel horn |
| Kiss | a text on reconciliation in its place (Strasbourg 1542, Moderate Reformed) | no kiss of altar, book or deacon; no pax-board |
| Incense | free at the gospel (*Formula missae*) | "censing" let go (Hannover 1536); prescribed nowhere |

## 2.16 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in a block quotation is listed below in date order, with the volume and pages of Sehling, the `eko.db` document that holds the text, and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in the text and tables can be found through the table in §2.5 and the section on each ordinary.

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, pp. 5, 6 | 2 | 2.3.2 |
| Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the Prior Volprecht, 1524 | 11, p. 39 | 247 | 2.13.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 138 | 1279 | 2.9.4 |
| Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 19/1, p. 129 | 1066 | 2.13.2 |
| Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Andreas Döber, 1525 | 11, p. 51 | 249 | 2.15.7 |
| Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 1525 | 4, pp. 32, 37–38 | 1832, 1833 | 2.4.4, 2.6.3, 2.12.1, 2.13.2 |
| Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, p. 14 | 3 | 2.3.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527 | 17/1, p. 49 | 755 | 2.15.3 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, pp. 196–197, 198 | 270 | 2.4.3, 2.13.2 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533 | 1, p. 704 | 148 | 2.7.1, 2.9.1 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4, p. 341 | 1856 | 2.4.2 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, draft order of service, 1535 | 17/1, p. 102 | 760 | 2.15.3 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 4, p. 356 | 1859 | 2.6.2 |
| Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542 | 13, p. 393 | 432 | 2.13.2 |
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1542 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 330 | 1311 | 2.15.9 |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 54, 55 | 1972 | 2.6.1, 2.7.2 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545 | 1, p. 301 | 33 | 2.12.1 |
| Palatinate, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546 | 14, pp. 96–97 | 472 | 2.4.5 |
| Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (German), 1547 | 24, p. 244 | 1669 | 2.14 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, p. 199 | 1922 | 2.10.1 |
| Danzig, first order of the Sunday Mass, 1557 | 4, p. 168 | 1844 | 2.15.2 |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed) | 14, p. 386 | 504 | 2.4.7 |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 231, 242–243 | 2257 | 2.9.2, 2.15.5 |
| Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8, p. 411 | 2272 | 2.9.4 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist) | 10, p. 151 | 182 | 2.15.3 |
| Synod of Petrikau, 1–3 June 1578 (Sandomierz consensus) | 4, p. 263 | 1846 | 2.15.3 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, p. 472 | 294 | 2.6.2 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, p. 613 | 1344 | 2.13.2 |
| Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618 | 13, p. 548 | 460 | 2.9.4 |

# Chapter 3. Mass Preliminaries

This chapter covers the parts of the evangelical Mass that are neither Ordinary nor Proper, in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks:

- **Opening versicles and preliminaries.** What stood before the Introit, and into what families do the orders fall?
- **The exhortation.** Where does the exhortation to the communicants fall, and what does it say?
- **The *Confiteor*, *Misereatur*, *Indulgentiam* and absolution.** Where are they? Does the priest say them alone, with his ministrants or sexton, or with the people? Are they said privately before Mass, at the beginning of Mass, or in the communion rite? Are the old texts kept or new ones written? Is the absolution optative, declaratory or indicative, and how does it compare with the modern Common Service?
- **Before and after the service.** Do the vesting prayers survive? Are the *Benedicite* and Ps 150 appointed after Mass, and who says them? Are there prayers before and after the sermon, on entering or leaving church, or for the communicants?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §3.1 summarizes the findings, and §3.2 sets out the scope and sources.
- §3.3 covers the opening versicles and preliminaries, by family.
- §3.4 covers the confession and absolution: placement, the chancel party, old and new texts, the form of the absolution, and the descent of the Common Service's confession.
- §3.5 covers the exhortation to the communicants: where it falls, and the families of text, each collated against its archetype, which is printed in full with a translation.
- §3.6 covers what comes before and after the service: vesting, the priest's private prayers, the *Benedicite* and Ps 150, prayers about the sermon, and prayers on entering church and at communion.
- §3.7 is a table by order, and §3.8 a concordance of every order quoted.

The Canon, the Words of Institution and the prayers around communion are treated in Chapter 7. Several texts printed there are only cross-referenced here: Kantz 1522, Döber's exhortation, the Kiel Mass and Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the whole order of the Mass, and where the preliminaries fall in it: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- private confession and absolution, and the examination of communicants: Chapter 13, §13.17;
- the hymns at the opening of the service: Chapter 8, §8.4;
- the prayers and notices around the sermon: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- confession and communion as duties of the laity: Chapter 15, §15.8.3;
- fasting before communion: Chapter 12, §12.13.6;
- vestments: Chapter 14, §14.7.

## 3.1 Summary of findings

1. **The Roman preparation was broken up.** No evangelical order keeps the whole of the priest's preparation: *Introibo*, Ps 43 *Iudica me*, *Confiteor*, *Misereatur*, *Indulgentiam* and *Aufer a nobis*. The one order that keeps most of it is Müntzer's Allstedt Mass (1523/1524; Radical Reformation): Ps 43 said by priest and people, then the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* and *Aufer a nobis*, all in German and aloud; *Introibo* survives there only as a verse of the psalm (§3.3.8). Elsewhere *Iudica me* disappears, and *Aufer a nobis* survives only in the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545 (after the sermon) and, on the editor's reading, at Regensburg 1542. *Adiutorium nostrum* (Ps 124:8) is the one versicle that survives widely. The German missals' *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus* survives in Döber and Mecklenburg 1540 (§3.3.1).

2. **The preliminaries fall into seven families** (§3.3.1):

    - **A.** The priest's private *Confiteor* at the altar during the Introit (Brandenburg-Nürnberg, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, Hohenlohe, Regensburg, Amberg, Buxtehude, Bergedorf, Schleswig-Holstein).
    - **B.** Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer with the sexton: the Our Father and *Domine, non secundum* (Wolfenbüttel, Hildesheim).

- **C.** The public confession of Döber (Nürnberg 1525), carried north to Lippe, Kiel and Mecklenburg and back south to Amberg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken and Pfalz-Veldenz. Amberg 1555 puts the confession in the plural, "Wir armen, sündige menschen" (§3.3.4).
- **D.** The medieval *Offene Schuld* of the preaching service moved into the Mass (Kantz, Bremen 1525, Volprecht, Naumburg, Nördlingen).
- **E.** The Strasbourg and Reformed opening: confession and comfortable word (Strasbourg 1537, Moderate Reformed; Palatinate 1563, Reformed).
- **F.** A hymn, a German psalm, or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* with its versicle and collect, the last a recasting of the medieval *accessus* as a preparation of the congregation (Luther 1526, Amberg 1544, Verden 1606, Transylvania 1547).
- **G.** Müntzer's German *Stufengebet* at Allstedt (Radical Reformation), with Ps 43 said by priest and people (§3.3.8).

3. **The confession stands in four places** (§3.4.1): privately before the Introit; publicly before the Introit; after the sermon (Bugenhagen 1528, Amberg 1550, the Palatinate); and in the communion rite after the exhortation (Kantz, Württemberg 1536, Nürnberg after 1569). Mecklenburg 1552 and Nördlingen 1544 have it twice.

4. **The chancel party** (§3.4.2):

   - **Families A and B.** The priest prays alone or with his ministrants (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg), or with the second ministrant in dialogue (Regensburg). In the north the sexton is the server: he kneels with the priest (Bugenhagen, Mecklenburg 1540), says the *Misereatur* (Kiel), or reads the absolution (Kiel, Hadeln).
   - **Family C.** In Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 "another minister or the custos" kneels beside the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness, and the choir answers the versicle.
   - **The people** keep silence and confess in their hearts (Mecklenburg), repeat the words after the priest (Döber, Bugenhagen's pulpit confession, Amberg's weekday prayer), or answer "Ja" (Palatinate 1563, Reformed).

5. **Before Mass.** The priest's *Confiteor* is said at the altar, not in the sacristy. The communicant's real preparation is private confession on the Saturday or before the service. The Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg orders forbid a "gemeine beicht" (common confession) in its place (§3.4.6).

6. **No Roman text is kept in public.** The Latin *Confiteor* survives only as the priest's private prayer, unprinted (Hohenlohe: "das reine Confiteor lateinisch"). Every public confession is a new text, in five families of wording (§3.4.3). The *Misereatur* survives by name at Kiel; as a prayer for "us" in Döber; and as the second minister's collect in Mecklenburg 1552. The *Indulgentiam* survives in Kantz's "Der allmechtig, barmherzig Gott vergeb euch euer sünd!" and in Döber's "Der almechtich, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet".

7. **Five kinds of absolution** (§3.4.4):

   - **optative** ("wöl sich unser erbarmen");
   - **declaration of grace** in the first person plural ("hat sich unser erbarmet … Das verleihe uns Got allen");
   - **indicative** ("sag euch frei, ledig und los"; "vorgebe ich euch"; "entbind ich euch");
   - **conditional declaration** with retention (Strasbourg 1537, Moderate Reformed; Palatinate 1563, Reformed);
   - **none**, only a word of comfort (Bugenhagen 1528).

   At the beginning of Mass the declaration of grace prevails; in the communion rite, the indicative.

8. **The Common Service descends from Mecklenburg** (§3.4.5). The Common Service's preparation is Döber's 1525 sequence by way of Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557. That sequence is the address "Beloved in the Lord", *Adiutorium*, the confession "by nature sinful and unclean", the prayer "O most merciful God", and the declaration "Almighty God … hath had mercy upon us … Grant this, O Lord, unto us all". The prayer "O most merciful God" was the second minister's *Misereatur*; the declaration is a declaration of grace, not an indicative absolution. The indicative form of later American books ("Upon this your confession … I forgive you all your sins") has its counterpart in Naumburg 1537.

9. **The exhortation** (§3.5) falls in six places:

   - after the sermon, from the pulpit or altar (Luther 1526, left free);
   - at the altar before the Verba (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, moved there at Luther's suggestion; Württemberg; the Palatinate 1563, Reformed);

- before the Preface, as the "true Preface" (Bugenhagen);
- after the Preface and Sanctus (Mecklenburg 1552; Naumburg 1537 before the Sanctus);
- after the Verba and Our Father (Nürnberg 1524–1525, Osiander's original place);
- after communion (Memmingen 1528, Moderate Reformed; Marienhafe 1593).

There are eleven families of text, each collated word by word against its archetype (§3.5.2): Luther 1526; Osiander 1524, with the Braunschweig recension of the north; Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Württemberg 1536, revised 1553; Bugenhagen 1528, in Low and High German; Naumburg 1537; Mecklenburg 1552, which contains an absolution; the Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), with its Lower Rhine recension (Reformed); Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; the Basel text (Reformed) of Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) and Neckarbischofsheim 1560; and Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed). Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed), Buxtehude 1565 and Micron (Reformed) each have an exhortation of their own (§3.5.14). Every archetype is given in full with a translation.

10. **No vesting prayers** (§3.6.1). None of the prayers in the Lutheran Missal Project's *Vesting Prayers* occurs in any order: the preparatory psalms, the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris*, the *preces* and collects, and the prayers at the washing of hands and at each vestment. Vestments are "frei" (indifferent). The priest vests in silence, at Hadeln during the *Te Deum* "nicht alse nödig" (not as needful). The *Stufengebet* alone of the medieval priest's three preparations survives. The *accessus* survives only as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus*.

11. **After Mass** (§3.6.3). The *Benedicite* and Ps 150 are never appointed after Mass. They occur only as the canticle and psalms of Sunday Lauds, sung by the schoolboys under the cantor or by the canons (Pomerania 1535, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Ansbach 1533). The priest's private thanksgiving survives only at Hildesheim 1544 and in Schleswig-Holstein 1542: he unvests during the closing hymn, kneels, and "danket Godde hemelick vor sick sülvest" (thanketh God secretly for himself), with no text given.

12. **Sermon, church door and communion** (§§3.6.4–3.6.5):

    - The sermon is framed by a bidding to prayer, the Our Father or a hymn of the Holy Ghost, and the general prayer after it. All are led by the preacher, with the people praying and the schoolboys singing.
    - No order prints a prayer for the worshipper on entering or leaving church, or private prayers for the communicant. Their place is taken by the opening hymn "wann man in die Kirche kompt" (Sayn 1590), the prayers the minister says for the communicants (Pfalz-Veldenz 1574), and the hymns during the distribution.
    - The nearest thing to a hymnal devotion is the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Gesangbuch* of 1571/1587, which prints the Mecklenburg confession and absolution for the people's use "vor der Predig am Sontag" (before the sermon on Sunday).

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## 3.2 Scope, sources and method

**Scope.** The chapter covers the evangelical (Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed) orders printed in Sehling's volumes 1–24. It deals with what the orders set before the Introit, the confession and absolution wherever they fall, the exhortation to the communicants, and the prayers before and after the service. It does not treat:

- the Ordinary and Propers (see Chapter 4);
- the collects (see Chapter 5);
- the general prayer (see Chapter 6);
- the Canon and the communion devotions (see Chapter 7);
- private confession (see Chapter 13 §13.17).

**Sources.** The quotations come from the `eko.db` database. Candidate passages were found by searching the whole corpus for:

- the Latin incipits *Confiteor*, *Misereatur*, *Indulgentiam*, *Introibo*, *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, *Ne reminiscaris*, *Quam dilecta*, *Benedicite* and *Laudate*;
- the German and Low German words for open confession and absolution (*offene beicht*, *offene schuld*, *gemeine beicht*, *bicht*, *absolutio*);
- the words for the exhortation (*vermanung*, *vormaninge*, *exhortatio*, *ermanung*), together with the address formulas ("Mein allerliebsten", "Lieben freunde", "Myne allerlevesten", "Ir geliebten");

- the words for vesting, the sacristy and the preparation (*ornat*, *messgewand*, *angekledet*, *praeparatio ad missam*, *Rüsthandlung*);
- prayers before and after the sermon, on entering church, and before and after communion.

Each hit was read in context. Editor's notes that identify a source or a medieval model are quoted where they bear on the question.

**Method and limits.**

- **Pages.** Each order is cited by Sehling's running head. Pages were checked against the page markers in the database.
- **Dates.** Some orders are dated differently in the database's record headings. Hadeln is printed by Sehling as the "Hadelner Kirchenordnung von 1526" within a record headed 1590. Verden's order is the *Kirchenordnung* of 1606 within a record headed 1612. Döber's Mass of 1525 lies within the record of the Nürnberg parish churches of 1524.
- **Coverage.** The exhortations were found by scanning every document in the corpus for wording shared with a known exhortation, and every witness found was collated against the archetype of its family (§3.5.2).
- **Negative findings.** That a form "does not occur" (vesting prayers, *Ne reminiscaris*, prayers on entering church) means that searches of the whole corpus for its Latin incipits and German equivalents found nothing. OCR damage can hide a passage, so such findings are strong but not absolute.

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## 3.3 Opening versicles and preliminaries

### 3.3.1 What the Roman Mass had, and what became of it

**The medieval preparation.** Before the Introit, the Roman Mass of the later Middle Ages had three layers of preparation for the priest:

1. **The *accessus*** (Akzess): a private office of psalms and prayers said before Mass.
2. **The *praeparatio ad missam*** in the sacristy: the washing of hands and a prayer at the putting on of each vestment.
3. **The prayers at the foot of the altar** (*Stufengebet*), said by the priest and server in dialogue:
    - the invocation, and *Introibo ad altare Dei* with Ps 43 *Iudica me*;
    - *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* (Ps 124:8);
    - the *Confiteor*, said first by the priest and then by the server;
    - the *Misereatur* ("May almighty God have mercy upon thee …"), said by each for the other;
    - the *Indulgentiam* ("May the almighty and merciful Lord grant us pardon, absolution and remission of our sins");
    - the versicles *Deus, tu conversus*, and the prayers *Aufer a nobis* and *Oramus te*.

Many German diocesan missals also had the versicle *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus / Quoniam in saeculum misericordia eius* (Ps 118:1) before the *Confiteor*.

**What became of it.** No evangelical order in Sehling keeps the whole of this. One order keeps a large part of it: Thomas Müntzer's German Mass for Allstedt (1523, printed 1524; Radical Reformation). There Ps 43 *Iudica me* is said by the priest and the whole people, and is followed by German forms of the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* and *Aufer a nobis*. *Introibo ad altare Dei* survives there only as the fourth verse of the psalm, not as an antiphon (§3.3.8). Elsewhere only fragments remain:

- *Aufer a nobis* is sung in Latin after the sermon in the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545, and Sehling's editor takes the collect after the *Confiteor* at Regensburg 1542 to be the same prayer (§3.3.8).
- The Mass form of the *Confiteor* is said by the priest with a deacon or fellow minister at Regensburg 1542 and Nördlingen 1544 (§3.3.2, §3.3.8).
- Sehling's editor prints the Bremen missal's *Stufengebet*, with *Introibo* and *Iudica*, as the background to the pastor's kneeling prayer at Buxtehude and Bergedorf (§3.3.2).

What survives falls into the families set out below:

| Family | Form | Who says it | Where | Orders (§) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| A | The priest's own *Confiteor* (or "what his devotion bids") at the altar, while the choir sings the Introit | The priest, sometimes with a ministrant or a fellow minister | Before or during the Introit | Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1553, Amberg 1550, Buxtehude 1552, Nördlingen 1544, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (3.3.2) |
| B | Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer: Our Father and the tract *Domine, non secundum* | The priest and the sexton, alternately | During the opening psalm | Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544 (3.3.3) |
| C | A public confession in the people's hearing, with *Adiutorium* and *Confitemini*, a recast *Misereatur* and a declaration of grace | The priest kneeling, with the sexton or a second minister; the people silently or repeating | At the very beginning of Mass | Döber 1525, Lippe [1525–1538], Kiel [after 1526], Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Amberg 1555, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hadeln (3.3.4) |
| D | The *Offene Schuld* moved into the Mass, with an indicative absolution | The priest to the people | Before the Introit, or before the Sacrament | Kantz 1522, Bremen 1525, Volprecht 1524, Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1544 (3.3.5) |
| E | The Upper German and Reformed opening of the preaching service: confession of sins and a comfortable word | The minister for the congregation | At the beginning of the service, or after the sermon | Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed), Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), Wertheim 1524 (3.6; and §3.4) |
| F | A hymn, a German psalm, or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* with its versicle and collect | Choir, schoolboys or congregation; the priest the collect | Before the Introit | Luther 1526, Amberg 1544, Verden 1606, Transylvania 1547, Buxtehude 1552, Mecklenburg villages, Sayn 1590 (3.3.7) |
| G | Ps 43 *Iudica me*, the *Confiteor*, the *Misereatur*, *Deus, tu conversus* and *Aufer a nobis*, in German | The priest and the whole people | Before the Introit | Müntzer, Allstedt 1523 and 1524 (Radical Reformation) (3.3.8) |

**The versicles that survive.**

- *Adiutorium nostrum* (Ps 124:8) is the one Roman versicle that survives widely: Kantz 1522, Döber 1525, Lippe, Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Poullain's French liturgy at Frankfurt (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 563) all have it.
- *Confitemini Domino quoniam bonus* (Ps 118:1) survives in Döber, Lippe and Mecklenburg 1540, but is dropped in Mecklenburg 1552.
- In Verden 1606 the versicle is *Emitte Spiritum tuum* (Ps 104:30), which belongs with *Veni Sancte Spiritus*.

### 3.3.2 Family A: the priest's own *Confiteor* at the altar

The commonest form in the south and in Brandenburg is a private preparation of the priest. He comes to the altar in his vestments, kneels and says the *Confiteor* or some other prayer of his own while the choir sings the Introit. The people take no part, and the text is not printed. The model is the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

> Ordnung der meß, wie die gehalten soll werden. Zum ersten, wenn der Priester zum altar kumbt, mag er das Confiteor oder, was ine sein andacht erinnert, sprechen, darnach den introitum lesen, doch das er aus der heiligen schrift

> genummen sei. Dieweil sollen die schuler, wo man schul hat, den introitum auch singen lateinisch. Wo man aber als in dörfern zu solichem lateinischen gesang nicht leut hette, soll man ein christenlich teutsch gesang nach gelegenheit jedes orts singen.

Order of the Mass, how the same shall be held. First, when the priest cometh to the altar, he may say the Confiteor, or what his devotion putteth him in mind of, and thereafter read the Introit, provided that it be taken out of the holy Scripture. Meanwhile the scholars, where there is a school, shall also sing the Introit in Latin. But where, as in villages, there were not people for such Latin singing, a Christian German hymn shall be sung, according to the occasion of each place.

The Mark Brandenburg adds the ministrants. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 67–68):

> Erstlich sol der priester, so die mess helt, samt seinen ministranten in iren gewönlichen kirchenornaten, nach gewonheit einer jeden kirchen zu dem altar gehen, anfenglich das confiteor sprechen; darnach soll der gewönlich introitus, folgend das kyrieeleison, nach gelegenheit, darauf das gloria in excelsis, welches sampt dem et in terra zu dem kyrie gehöret, gesungen werden

First, the priest that holdeth the Mass, together with his ministrants, in their accustomed church ornaments, according to the custom of each church, shall go to the altar and at the beginning say the Confiteor. Thereafter shall be sung the accustomed Introit, then the Kyrie eleison, as occasion serveth, and upon that the Gloria in excelsis, which together with the Et in terra belongeth to the Kyrie.

Pfalz-Neuburg copies Brandenburg, but makes the priest kneel and allows a penitential psalm instead. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 70):

> Erstlich soll der priester, so die meß halten will, sampt seinen ministranten, wo und wann man dieselben zu gebrauchen pflegt, in iren gewonlichen kirchenornaten nach gewonheit einer jeden kirchen zu dem altar gehn und anfenglich darvor kniend das Confiteor oder ein feinen bußpsalm sprechen.

First, the priest that will hold the Mass, together with his ministrants (where and when they are wont to be used), shall go to the altar in their accustomed church ornaments, according to the custom of each church, and at the beginning, kneeling before it, say the Confiteor or a goodly penitential psalm.

Hohenlohe insists on the Latin text of the Missal. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 68):

> Zum ersten soll der pfarrherr in seinem ornat und kirchengewand vor deim altar kommen, niderknyen und das reine Confiteor lateinisch betten. Indes soll der schulmaynster sampt den schulern denn introitum lateinisch singen de tempore, aber allein die, so der heyligen geschrift gemeß sind.

First, the parson shall come before the altar in his ornament and church vesture, kneel down, and pray the pure Confiteor in Latin. Meanwhile the schoolmaster with the scholars shall sing the Introit *de tempore* in Latin, but only those that are agreeable to the holy Scripture.

**Editor's note** (p. 68). "Confiteor ist das Sündenbekenntnis als Teil des Stufengebetes … Hier ist das Stück aus der Messe gemeint, während in der Brand. KO 1533 (Sehling 11, 188) nur ein entsprechendes Stück gefordert war." (The Confiteor is the confession of sins that is part of the prayers at the foot of the altar. Here the piece from the Mass itself is meant, whereas the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 required only a corresponding piece.) What "reine" (pure) is meant to exclude is not said; presumably the invocation of the Virgin and the saints.

At Regensburg the *Confiteor* is said in dialogue with the second of two ministrants. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, pp. 419–420):

> so kombt der priester (das ist der minister, welcher, wie obstehet, wochner ist) sambt zwaien ministranten oder diaconen fur den altar und […] betet also mit dem einen ministranten (der dazumal secundus ist) das Confiteor kniend. Unterdes singt der chor den introitum de tempore lateinisch und die Kyrie eleison zu dreien malen.

then cometh the priest (that is, the minister who, as is said above, is hebdomadary) together with two ministrants or deacons before the altar, and prayeth thus with the one ministrant (who is for that time the second) the Confiteor kneeling. Meanwhile the choir singeth the Introit *de tempore* in Latin and the Kyrie eleison three times.

At Amberg the choir sings an antiphon of the season or *Veni Sancte* over the priest's *Confiteor*, and the priest then sings a collect. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, p. 285):

> Die meß würd bei uns schier durchaus wie von alters herkommen mit gewonlicher kleidung, liechtern, gesengen und anderen ornaten aufs zierlichist gehalten; den erstlich betet der briester vor dem altar knieend das Confiteor. Unter disem singet der chor Haec est dies oder Veni, Sancte und der briester darauf Oremus und collectam. Darauf singet der chorus den introitum von der dominica und fürfallenden ordenlichen festen.

The Mass is held with us almost throughout as it hath come down of old, with the accustomed vesture, lights, chants and other ornaments, most seemly; for first the priest prayeth the Confiteor kneeling before the altar. During this the choir singeth *Haec est dies* or *Veni Sancte*, and the priest thereupon *Oremus* and the collect. Thereupon the choir singeth the Introit of the Sunday and of the ordinary feasts that fall.

**Editor's note** (p. 285): "Wahrscheinlich nicht das im Wechsel mit dem Ministranten gesprochene der Messe, sondern wie auch 1533 (Sehling 11, 188) ein stilles Gebet." (Probably not the *Confiteor* of the Mass said in alternation with the ministrant, but, as also in 1533, a silent prayer.)

In the north the same private prayer appears at Buxtehude. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

> Under dem introitu schall der preister, mit gewontliken missengewande ahngetagen, vor dat altar gahn unde vor des altares vote syn gebedt und confessie dohn.

During the Introit the priest, clad in the accustomed Mass vestment, shall go before the altar and at the altar's foot make his prayer and confession.

Sehling's editor sets this against the Bremen missal of 1511. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552, editor's note** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

> Das Stufengebet des Pastors, dort vor dem Introitus vorgesehen, da der Pastor den Introitus mitsingen muß, erwähnt Aepin in seiner Bergedorfer KO von 1544; vgl. Sehling V, 387. […] Stufengebet nach dem Missale eccl. Brem. 1511: Ante altare sacerdos dicat: Introibo ad altare Dei… [Ps 43, 4]. Ps. Iudica me Deus etc. [Ps 43]. Deinde dicat confessionem [Confiteor, Sündenbekenntnis]. Et introibo etc.

The pastor's prayer at the foot of the altar, appointed there before the Introit because the pastor must sing the Introit with [the choir], is mentioned by Aepinus in his Bergedorf church order of 1544. […] The prayers at the foot of the altar according to the Bremen missal of 1511: Before the altar let the priest say: *Introibo ad altare Dei*. The psalm *Iudica me Deus*, etc. Then let him say the confession. *Et introibo*, etc.

The Bergedorf order to which the note refers has the same private prayer, before the opening psalm or Introit. **Bergedorf, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 5, p. 387):

> In der misse schall desse ordenunge gehalden werden. Die pastor mit gewöntlichen missgewande edder klederen angetagen, schall anfencklich up dem voth vor dem altare nedder knien unde sein gebeth tho gott dahn, wenn he up steith, schall he mit einem duideschen psalmo, edder ahn den festen mit einem lateinischen introitu de trinitate edder spiritu sancto (so he huilpe hefft, de ock singen konnen) anheven unde singen.

In the Mass this order shall be kept. The pastor, clad in the accustomed Mass vestment or clothes, shall first kneel down at the foot before the altar and make his prayer to God; when he standeth up, he shall begin and sing with a German psalm, or on the feasts with a Latin Introit of the Trinity or of the Holy Ghost (if he have help, that can also sing).

Neither order says what the prayer is. Nothing in Sehling shows that *Introibo* and *Iudica* were said there; the editor gives the missal's form for comparison.

In Schleswig-Holstein 1542 the priest falls on his knees before the altar and reads the *Confiteor* "by sick" (to himself), with an intercession for the preachers, the king and the duchies (Sehling 23, p. 89; quoted in full in Chapter 7 §7.15.3).

**Nördlingen 1544: the private and the public confession side by side.** Kaspar Löner's order keeps both. The celebrant first receives absolution from a fellow minister on his own *Confiteor*, while two choirs, the school and the people, sing *Kum, heiliger*

*Geist* or *Nun bitten wir* in alternation. Then he turns to the people and says the open confession and the absolution for them. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, pp. 311–312):

> An hohen festen soll der pfarrer selbs das hohe ampt halten, an den andern aber und suntagen der alte pfarrer in seiner geburlichen kleidung fur den alter kumen, alda die absolution von einem seiner mitdiener empfahen auf sein Confiteor hin. Indes sollen zwen chore - einer der schulen, der ander des volks - an hohen festen singen umb einander Kum, hailiger Geist, alle drei gesetze aus. An andern festen aber und sonntagen Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Gaist mit allen seinen gesetzen. Wen das aus ist, sol der celebrant sich zu dem volk wenden oder, so man je wollt im chor bleiben, […] herausgen fur den alter, alldau das Confiteor oder offne beicht dem volk fursprechen und darauf die absolution.

On high feasts the pastor himself shall hold the high office, but on the others and on Sundays the old pastor shall come before the altar in his due vesture, and there receive the absolution from one of his fellow ministers upon his Confiteor. Meanwhile two choirs, the one of the school, the other of the people, shall on high feasts sing *Kum, hailiger Geist* in turn, all three stanzas out; but on other feasts and Sundays *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Gaist* with all its stanzas. When that is out, the celebrant shall turn to the people, or, if they would needs remain in the choir, come out before the altar, and there say before the people the Confiteor or open confession, and thereupon the absolution.

**Editor's notes** (pp. 311–312). On the celebrant's *Confiteor* (p. 311):

> Hiemit ist also eine nur für den Geistlichen und seinen Ministranten bestimmte Rüsthandlung gemeint wie Brandenburg 1540 (Sehling 3, 67f.) und Pfalz-Neuburg 1542 […] oder - auf den Geistlichen beschränkt — Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, 188) und in V. Dietrichs Agendbüchlein 1543 (Sehling 11, 495). Ob sie sich nur auf das Confiteor und das Misereatur samt dem Indulgentiam im engsten Sinn bezieht oder ob damit das ganze Stufengebet, das übrigens in den Meßbüchern vor 1570 nicht enthalten ist, sondern anderweit bekannt sein muß […], der Messe gemeint ist, läßt sich nicht entscheiden

What is meant here, then, is a preparation appointed only for the clergyman and his ministrant, as in Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1542, or, restricted to the clergyman, in Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 and in V. Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1543. Whether it refers only to the Confiteor and the Misereatur together with the Indulgentiam in the narrowest sense, or whether the whole prayers at the foot of the altar of the Mass are meant (which, moreover, are not contained in the missals before 1570, but must have been known from elsewhere), cannot be decided.

On the open confession to the people (p. 312):

> Die Offene Schuld ist hier ein allgemein gottesdienstlicher Rüstgottesdienst für die Gemeinde wie etwa auch bei Volprecht (Sehling 11, 39f.) und Döber (Sehling 11, 51), nicht ein Ersatz für die Beichte oder deren Wiederholung wie bei Kantz (unsere Nr. VIII 1) oder in Nürnberg (Sehling 11, 498 Anm. 5)

The Open Confession is here a general preparatory service of worship for the congregation, as also with Volprecht and Döber; not a substitute for confession, or its repetition, as with Kantz or in Nürnberg.

**What family A shows.**

- **No text.** The orders do not print the *Confiteor* they mean. Brandenburg-Nürnberg leaves the choice to the priest's "andacht"; Hohenlohe alone demands the "pure" Latin *Confiteor* of the Missal.
- **Who.** The priest alone (Brandenburg-Nürnberg, Hohenlohe, Amberg, Buxtehude, Schleswig-Holstein), with his ministrants (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg), with the second ministrant in dialogue (Regensburg), or with a fellow minister who absolves him (Nördlingen).
- **When.** At the altar, kneeling, during the Introit or the opening hymn. It is never said in the sacristy, and never before the bells.
- **The people** do not hear it. It is the evangelical remnant of the *Stufengebet*.

#### 3.3.3 Family B: Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer with the sexton

Bugenhagen's later orders replace the *Confiteor* with the Our Father and the tract *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra* (Ps 103:10; Ps 79:8–9). The priest kneels with the sexton and prays "vor sick und vor dat volk und vor alle nött der christenheit" (for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom). The sexton answers each versicle. This is the form in

Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 54–55) and Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852). Both texts, with translations and the full versicles, are in Chapter 7 §§7.15.1–7.15.2.

**Note.**

- The prayer is said aloud but at the altar, during the opening German psalm, so that in practice the people would not have followed it.
- The versicle *Domine, ne memineris iniquitatum nostrarum antiquarum* (Ps 79:8) is the nearest thing in the corpus to the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* of the Missal's preparation (Tobit 3:3), which does not occur (§3.6.2).

### 3.3.4 Family C: Döber and the Mecklenburg public confession

**The form.** This is the most important family, because it is the source of the modern Lutheran confession of sins (§3.4.5). It keeps the shape of the Roman *Stufengebet* but speaks it aloud, in German, in the people's hearing:

1. an address to the people: "My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts …";
2. the priest kneels; *Adiutorium nostrum* and *Confitemini Domino*;
3. a new confession in the first person singular ("I, poor sinful man …"), said by the priest for all;
4. a prayer for forgiveness in the plural, in the place of the *Misereatur*;
5. a declaration of God's mercy, in the place of the *Indulgentiam*, ending "Das verleihe uns Got allen" (God grant this unto us all).

It begins in Nürnberg with Andreas Döber's Mass for the New Hospital. **Nürnberg, Andreas Döber, *Von der evangelischen meß … im Newen Spital*, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 51):

> Mit ersten, wenn der priester über altar kumbt und den kelch aus dem sack geton hat, kert er sich zum volk und spricht laut, wie hernach volgt (auch alle wort, die in der ganzen meß sind), so das er doch verstentlich sei den zuhörern: Mein aller liebsten in Got, eroffent eur herzen und last uns Got unser sünd bekennen, und sprecht mir nach mit herzlicher begird im namen des Vaters und des Suns und des Heilgen Geists! Amen. In dem kniet der priester nider für den altar und spricht fein lanksam wie hernach volgt. Unser hilf sei im namen des Herren, der erschaffen hat himel und erden! Bekennet dem Herren; dann er ist gut und sein barmherzigkeit ist ewich. Und ich armer, sündiger mensch bekenn Got dem allmechtigen, meinem schöpfer und erlöser, das ich nit allein gesündiget hab mit gedanken, worten oder werken sonder auch in sünden empfangen und geborn, also das alle mein natur und wesen vor seiner gerechtigkeit streflich und verdamlich ist. Darumb fleuhe ich zu seiner grundlosen barmherzigkeit, such und bite genad. Herr, bis genedich mir armen sünder! Der barmherzig Got wöl sich unser erbarmen und uns unsere sünd verzeihen und den Heiligen Geist geben, […] das wir durch in seinen götlichen willen erfüllen und das ewig leben empfangen. Amen. Die absolution. Spricht der priester: Neigt eur herz zu Got! Der almechtich, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet und seinen einigen Sun für unser sünd in tod geben und umb seinet willen uns verzihen, auch allen den, die an seinen heiligen namen glauben, Gottes kinder zu werden gewalt geben und den Heiligen Geist verheißen. Wer glaubt und getauft würt, der sol selig sein. Das verleihe uns Got allen. Amen. Und einem jglichen geschehe nach seinem glauben! In dem, do er spricht: Bit Got für mich, desselben gleichen will ich auch tun! stehet er auf für den altar und spricht für das volk (auch mag das volk mit im beten) also: Kum, Heiliger Geist, erfülle die herzen deiner glaubigen und entzünde in ihnen das feuer deiner götlichen lieb, der du durch mancherlei zungen hast gesammelt die völker der ganzen welt in einigkeit des glaubens! Got sei gelobet!

First, when the priest cometh to the altar and hath taken the chalice out of the bag, he turneth to the people and speaketh aloud, as hereafter followeth (and so also all the words that are in the whole Mass), so that he may yet be understood of the hearers: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, and let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with hearty desire, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost! Amen. Therewith the priest kneeleth down before the altar and saith full slowly as hereafter followeth. Our help be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth! Confess unto the Lord, for he is good, and his mercy is everlasting. And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and pray for grace. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner! The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and forgive us our sins, and give us the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life. Amen. The absolution. The priest saith: Incline your heart to God! The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and hath given his only Son unto death for our

sins, and for his sake forgiven us; and to all them also that believe on his holy name he hath given power to become the children of God, and hath promised the Holy Ghost. He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all. Amen. And unto every one be it done according to his faith! As he saith: Pray God for me, the same will I also do for you! he standeth up before the altar and saith for the people (and the people also may pray with him) thus: Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through divers tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the faith! God be praised!

**Note.**

- **The Roman skeleton.** *Adiutorium* and *Confitemini* are the versicles of the German missals. "Der barmherzig Got wöl sich unser erbarmen …" is the *Misereatur*, now in the plural ("unser", us) and said by the priest for priest and people together. "Der almechtich, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet …" stands where the *Indulgentiam* stood, and its opening words echo it.
- **The *Orate fratres*.** "Bit Got für mich, desselben gleichen will ich auch tun" is the Roman request for the people's prayers, moved here from the offertory.
- **The absolution** is a declaration in the perfect tense ("hat sich unser erbarmet", hath had mercy) that ends in a wish ("Das verleihe uns Got allen", God grant this unto us all). It is neither the indicative "I absolve you" nor the optative *Misereatur*; see §3.4.4.
- **Sehling's editor** notes that the *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen meß* (Sehling 11, pp. 56 ff.) takes over this beginning, headed "Das Confiteor".

The Low German Mass of Lippe follows Döber. The choir sings the Introit or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* while the priest reads the confession. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 565):

> Thom ersten lest de prester den confiteor. De confiteor Unse hulpe sy in dem namen des heren, de gheschapen heyfft hemmel und erden. Bekennet dem heren, wente he ys gudt und syne barmharticheit ys ewich. Unde ik arme sündige mynsche bekenne Gade dem almechtigen, mynen schepper und vorloser, dat ik nicht allene ghesündiget hebbe myt dancken, worden edder wercken, sunder ok yn sünden entfangen und gebaren byn, also dat all myne natür und wesent vor syner barmharticheit strafflick und vordomlick ys, darumme flee ik tho syner grundelosen barmharticheit, soke und bydde gnade. Here, wes my armen sünder barmhartich. De absolutio De almechtige, barmhertige Godt, de vor unse sünde synen eynygen sone in den doet ghegeven heyfft, wolde syck unser erbarmen und uns umme synent wyllen unse sünde vorgeven und den hilligen geist vorlenen allen, de an en loven, dat wy dorch en synen godtliken wyllen vorvullen unde dat ewyghe levent entfangen, amen. […] Dewyle averst de prester den confiteor lest, synget dat choer den introitum der misse.

First the priest readeth the Confiteor. The Confiteor. Our help be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth. Confess unto the Lord, for he is good, and his mercy is everlasting. And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his mercy punishable and damnable; therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and pray for grace. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The absolution. The almighty, merciful God, who for our sins hath given his only Son unto death, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for his sake forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost unto all that believe on him, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life, amen. […] But while the priest readeth the Confiteor, the choir singeth the Introit of the Mass.

**Note.** Here the optative prayer ("wolde syck unser erbarmen", vouchsafe to have mercy) is itself headed "De absolutio". Döber's declaration is missing.

The Kiel Mass takes Döber's address and confession, but its absolution is Kantz's indicative form, and it is read by the sexton. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* (Kiel), [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, p. 55):

> De Confiteor Myne alderlevesten yn Godt, opent iwe harte unde latet uns Gade unße sunde bekennen unde spricket my na myt bogerlykem hartenn: Im namen des vaders unde des sones unde des hilgen gestes. Amen. Ick arme, sündige mynsche bokenne my Gade, dem almechtigen, myneme scipper unde varrloßer, dat ik nycht allene gesundyget hebbe myt danken, worden edder warken, ßunder ock yn sunden entfangen unde gebaren bynn, alßo dat al myne natur unde wesenth vann syner rechtferdicheyt strafflich unde vordomlyck ys. Darumme hebbe yck thoflucht tho syner gruntloßenn barmharticheyt, ßoke und bogere gnade: Here, wes gnedich my arme sunder. De barmehertyge Godt wolde syck unßer

> vorbarmen unde uns unße ßunde vorgevenn unde den hilgen ghest vorlenen, dat wy dorch en ßynen godelykenn wyllen erfüllen unde dat ewyge leven entfangen. Amen.

The Confiteor. My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts and let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with desirous heart: In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. I, poor sinful man, confess myself unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore have I refuge unto his bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace: Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life. Amen.

There follow the *Misereatur*, read by minister and sexton, and an absolution read by the sexton: "Unde yck, uth bevele unßes heren Jesu Christi, segge jwe … frigh, leddich unde loß alle jwe sunde" (And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, say unto you … free, quit and loosed of all your sins; Sehling 23, p. 55; full text in Chapter 7 §7.11.1). "Ick hebbe thoflucht" (I have refuge) is the reading that Mecklenburg and the later orders keep.

**Mecklenburg 1540: the country Mass.** The Low German *Ordeninge der misse* puts the confession at the head of every communion Mass. The sexton, "or another Christian", kneels with the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1540/1545** (Sehling 5, pp. 150–151):

> Eine gemene misse vor dejenen, de sick willen laten berichten, schall des sondages unde up ander festdage, in gewontliken missegewande geholden werden up enem altare, dat dar to beredet und gedecket sin schall. De prester, wenn he sick hefft angekledet, wende he sick vor dem altare umme . und segge to dem volke: Mine alder levesten in godt, eröpent juwe herte, latet uns gade unse sünde bekennen, unde spreket mi na mit hertlikem begere. Im namen des vaders, des söns unde des hilligen geistes, amen. Denne valle he up sine knee vor dem altare, und de koster edder ein ander christen bi eme, denne segge aver lut de kerckhere. Unse hülpe si im namen des heren. Antwort. De geschapen hefft hemmel unde erde. De prester. Bekennet dem heren, wente he is gut. Antwort. Unde sine barmherticheit is ewich. De prester. Unde ick arme sündige minsche, bekenne gade dem almechtigen, minem schepper unde vorloeser, dat ick nicht allene gesündiget hebbe mit gedanken , worden edder werken, sonder ock in sünden entfangen und gebaren bin, also, dat alle min natur unde wesent vor siner gerechticheit straflich unde vordömlick is. Darumme flehe ick to siner grundlosen barmherticheit, söke und begere gnade, here wes gnedich mi armen sünder. De dener antwerdet dit gebet. De almechtige barmhertige godt, de vor unse sünde sinen enigen söne in den dodt gegeven hefft, wolde sick unser erbarmen, unde uns umme sinent willen unse sünde vorgeven, und den hilligen geist vorlenen, dat wy dorch en sinen gödtliken willen erfüllen, unde dat ewige levent entfangen, amen. De prester spreckt hirna dese absolution. De barmhertige godt hefft sick unser erbarmet, unde vor uns sinen enigen söne in den dot gegeven, unde uns umme sinent willen unse sünde vorgeven. Ock alle den, de an sinen hiligen namen gelöven gades kinder to werden gewalt gegeven, unde den hilligen geist vorheten. Wol gelövet unde gedöfft wert, de schall salich werden. Dat vorlene uns godt allen, amen. Wenn desse bicht van dem prester gespraken wert, schall de ganze kercke stille sin, unde desse bicht anhören, ock mit dem prester also ere sünde bekennen, unde dat bedt mit der absolution leren, to der tidt, und ock sunst yo vaken vor gade reden. Hirna schall in den steden de cantor edder scholmester den introitum anfangen to latin, effte singen under tiden enen düdeschen psalm.

A common Mass for them that will be communicated shall be held on Sundays and other feast days in the accustomed Mass vestment, upon an altar that shall be prepared and covered for the purpose. The priest, when he hath vested himself, let him turn about before the altar and say to the people: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, let us confess our sins unto God, and say after me with hearty desire. In the name of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, amen. Then let him fall upon his knees before the altar, and the sexton or another Christian by him; then let the parson say aloud: Our help be in the name of the Lord. Answer: Who hath made heaven and earth. The priest: Confess unto the Lord, for he is good. Answer: And his mercy is everlasting. The priest: And I, poor sinful man, confess unto God almighty, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words or works, but was also conceived and born in sins, so that all my nature and being is before his righteousness punishable and damnable. Therefore I flee unto his bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace; Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The minister answereth this prayer: The almighty, merciful God, who for our sins hath given his only Son unto death, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for his sake forgive us our sins, and grant the Holy Ghost, that through him we may fulfil his divine will and receive everlasting life, amen. The priest saith hereafter this absolution: The merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and hath given his only Son unto death for us, and for his sake forgiven us our sins; and to all them also that

believe on his holy name he hath given power to become the children of God, and hath promised the Holy Ghost. Whoso believeth and is baptized, he shall be saved. God grant this unto us all, amen. When this confession is spoken by the priest, the whole church shall be still and hear this confession, and also confess their sins with the priest in like manner, and learn the prayer with the absolution, [to say it] at that time, and also otherwise right often before God. Hereafter in the towns the cantor or schoolmaster shall begin the Introit in Latin, or sing at times a German psalm.

The church order of 1552 puts the same form into High German and makes it the beginning of every Mass. The wording of the confession changes here into the form the later orders keep. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 197–198):

> Mess oder communio, Die sol, wie vorhin in diesem lande geordnet und im brauch ist, mit der gemeinen oder öffentlichen beicht, gebet und absolution, durch den priester angefangen werden. Nemlich also. Der priester wende sich fur dem altar um gegen dem volk, und spreche. Mein allerliebsten in gott, eröffnet euere herzen, last uns gott unsere sünden bekennen, und um vergebung, im namen unsers herrn Jesu Christi bitten. Sprecht mir nach mit herzlichem begeren zu gott, im glauben an den herrn Jesum Christum, durch den heiligen geist. Denn kniet der priester nieder, fur den altar, und ein ander kirchendiener oder custos neben in, und spricht der priester mit lauter stimme. Unser hülf stehet im namen des herrn. Antwort der Chor. Der geschaffen hat himel und erden. Der priester. Ich armer sündiger mensch, bekenne fur dir, o allmechtiger gott, meinem schöpfer und erlöser, das ich gesündiget hab, nicht alleine mit gedanken, worten und werken, sondern das ich auch von natur sündig und unrein bin, in sünden empfangen und geboren. Ich hab aber zuflucht zu deiner grundlosen barmherzigkeit, suche und begere gnade, um des herrn Jesu Christi willen. Herr sei gnedig mir armen sünder. Der ander diener antwort dieses gebet. O allmechtiger barmherziger gott, der du deinen eingebornen son für uns in den tod gegeben hast, wollest dich unser erbarmen, und um desselben deines geliebten sons willen, uns alle unsere sünd vergeben. Auch deinen heiligen geist uns geben, der in uns wares erkentnis deines göttlichen wesens und willens, dazu waren gehorsam gegen dir anzünde und vermehre. Uff das wir das ewige leben, durch deine gnad, um des herrn Jesu Christi willen erlangen, amen. Der priester spricht hernach diese absolution. Der allmechtige barmherzige gott hat sich unser erbarmet, vergibt uns warhaftiglich alle unsere sünd, um seines lieben sons willen, den er um unsert willen hat in den tod gegeben, und hat macht gegeben, gottes kinder zu werden, allen, die an seinen namen gleuben, gibet uns dazu seinen heiligen geist, wer gleubt und getauft wird, sol selig werden. Das verleihe uns gott allen, amen. Dieweil diese beicht, gebet und absolution, gesprochen wird, sol die ganze kirch stille sein und solchs anhören, auch mit dem priester also bekennen, beten, und die absolution zu herzen fassen, wol lernen, und fur gott oft desgleichen sprechen. Ernach singet der chor den introitum de dominica oder festo.

Mass or communion. The same shall be begun, as heretofore ordained and in use in this land, with the common or public confession, prayer and absolution, by the priest; namely thus. The priest shall turn about before the altar toward the people, and say: My dearly beloved in God, open your hearts, let us confess our sins unto God, and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ. Say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, through the Holy Ghost. Then the priest kneeleth down before the altar, and another minister of the church or the custos beside him, and the priest saith with a loud voice: Our help standeth in the name of the Lord. The choir answereth: Who hath made heaven and earth. The priest: I, poor sinful man, confess before thee, O almighty God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have sinned not only in thoughts, words and works, but that I am also by nature sinful and unclean, conceived and born in sins. But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake. Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. The other minister answereth this prayer: O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same thy beloved Son forgive us all our sins; and also give us thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle and increase in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee; to the end that we may obtain everlasting life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, amen. The priest saith hereafter this absolution: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins for the sake of his dear Son, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost; he that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all, amen. While this confession, prayer and absolution is spoken, the whole church shall be still and hear it, and also with the priest likewise confess, pray, and take the absolution to heart, learn it well, and often say the like before God. After this the choir singeth the Introit *de dominica* or *de festo*.

**Note.**

- **"wie vorhin in diesem lande geordnet"** points back to 1540.
- **What changes from 1540.**

    - The *Confitemini* versicle is dropped. The choir, not the sexton, answers *Adiutorium*.
    - The confession turns from the third person ("bekenne gade", confess unto God) to the second ("bekenne fur dir, o allmechtiger gott", confess before thee, O almighty God).
    - It adds "von natur sündig und unrein" (by nature sinful and unclean) and "Ich hab aber zuflucht zu deiner grundlosen barmherzigkeit" (But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy).
    - The second minister's prayer becomes a collect with a relative clause ("der du …") and asks for "wares erkentnis … dazu waren gehorsam" (true knowledge … and true obedience).
    - The absolution gains "vergibt uns warhaftiglich alle unsere sünd" (forgiveth us truly all our sins), in the present tense.
- **The people.** In 1540 and 1552 the people are told to keep silence, confess with the priest in their hearts, and learn the text. They do not say it aloud, despite the "Sprecht mir nach" (say after me) of the address. The address keeps the phrase from Döber.
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken** copies 1552 word for word (below).

**Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574: the Mecklenburg form in the Palatinate.** The Zweibrücken order prints the 1552 form whole, after an opening hymn to the Holy Ghost sung "until the church gathers". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 18, p. 187):

> So denn das Abendmal Christi auff ein Sontag oder andern Feirtag in der Kirchen zu halten fürgenommen wirdt, soll anfengklich das gesang, Komm heyliger Geyst etc., Nun bitten wir den heyligen Geyst etc. oder sonst ein Teutscher Psalm oder geystlich lied, sonderlich der zeyt gemeß, gesungen werden, biß die Kirch zusammen kombt. […] Denn kniet der Priester nider für dem Altar, und ein ander Kirchendiener oder Custos neben im, und spricht der Priester mit lauter stimme: Unser hilffe stehet im namen des Herrn. Antwort der Chor: Der geschaffen hat himel und erden.

When, then, the Supper of Christ is purposed to be held in the church on a Sunday or other holy day, there shall first be sung the hymn *Komm heyliger Geyst*, etc., *Nun bitten wir den heyligen Geyst*, etc., or else a German psalm or spiritual song, especially one agreeable to the season, until the church cometh together. […] Then the priest kneeleth down before the altar, and another minister of the church or the custos beside him, and the priest saith with a loud voice: Our help standeth in the name of the Lord. The choir answereth: Who hath made heaven and earth.

**Editor's notes** (p. 187). The section from here to the Words of Institution is "aus KO Mecklenburg 1552". The Zweibrücken hymnal of 1571/1587 reprints it under the heading "Beicht, Gebett und Absolutio vor der Predig am Sontag" (Confession, prayer and absolution before the sermon on Sunday), that is, as the opening of every Sunday service, communion or not.

Pfalz-Veldenz takes over the Zweibrücken text with one change that matters: the second minister has gone, and the minister says the confession, the prayer for forgiveness and the absolution himself, kneeling for the first two and standing for the third. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, pp. 498–499):

> Wann man, das Abendtmahl zuhalten, bey einander versamlet ist, soll erstlich der Tisch des herrn, wölchen man sonnst den altar nennet, mit einem rainen, weissen thuch gedeckhet, mit Brodt und Wein beraith sein, als dann fahet man an zu singen, knüehendt: Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist. Oder: Khom, heiliger Geist etc. Darauff vermahnet der Pfarrer zur bekantnus der sünden und hertzlichem gebett umb verzeyhung derselbigen, ungefarlich mit solchen wortten: Meine aller liebsten in dem herrn, lasset uns Gott unnsere Sünde bekhennen und umb vergebung in dem Namen unnsers herrn Jesu Christi bitten, Eröffnet derhalben ewere hertzen und sprecht mir nach mit hertzlichen begehren zu Gott im glauben an den herrn Christum durch den heiligen Geist. […] Dann kniehet der dhiener nider und spricht dem volckh für mit lautter Stimme: Ich armer sündiger Mensch bekhenn vor dir, o allmechtiger Gott, meinem Schöpffer und Erlöser, das ich leider vil gesündiget hab, nicht allein mit gedanckhen, wortten und werckhen, sonder das ich von Natur sündig und unrein bin, in sünden Empfangen und geborn. Ich hab aber zuflucht zu deiner grundtlosen Barmhertzigkheit, suche und begehre gnade umb des herrn Jesu Christi willen; herr, sey gnedig mir armen sünder. Allmechtiger, barmhertziger Gott, der du deinen Eingebornen Sohn für uns in den Todt gegeben hast, wöllest dich unnser erbarmen unnd umb desselbigen, deines geliebten Sohns, willen uns all unnser Sünden verzeyhen, auch deinen heiligen Geist geben, der in uns wahre erkantnus deines göttlichen wesens unnd willens, darzu wahren gehorsam gegen dir anzünde und vermehre, uff das wir diß unnser leben nach allem deinem wolgefallen hinbringen und hernach das ewige leben durch dein gnadt umb des herrn Jesu Christi willen erlangen etc. Absolutio würdt gesprochen von dem dhiener, wann er auffgestanden: Der allmechtig, barmhertzig Gott hat sich unnser erbarmet, vergibt uns warhafftig all unnsere sünde und Missethat umb seines geliebten Sohns willen, den er umb unsert willen hat in den todt gegeben, und hat macht geben, khinder Gottes

> zuwerden, allen, die an seinen Namen glauben, gibt unns darzu seinen heiligen Geist, der uns erleucht und in alle warheit leitte, das wir seelig werden, das verleyhe uns Gott allen, durch Jesum Christum, unnsern hailandt. Amen.

When they are assembled together to hold the Supper, the table of the Lord, which is otherwise called the altar, shall first be covered with a clean white cloth and be made ready with bread and wine; then they begin to sing, kneeling: *Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist*, or *Khom, heiliger Geist*, etc. Thereupon the pastor exhorteth to the confession of sins and to hearty prayer for the forgiveness of the same, about with such words: My dearly beloved in the Lord, let us confess our sins unto God and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ; open therefore your hearts and say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Christ, through the Holy Ghost. […] Then the minister kneeleth down and saith before the people with a loud voice: I, poor sinful man, confess before thee, O almighty God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I have, alas, sinned much, not only in thoughts, words and works, but that I am by nature sinful and unclean, conceived and born in sins. But I have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, seek and desire grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake; Lord, be merciful to me a poor sinner. Almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same, thy beloved Son, forgive us all our sins; also give thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle and increase in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee, to the end that we may pass this our life according to all thy good pleasure, and hereafter obtain everlasting life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake, etc. The absolution is spoken by the minister when he hath stood up: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins and misdeeds for the sake of his beloved Son, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost, who enlighteneth us and leadeth us into all truth, that we may be saved; God grant this unto us all, through Jesus Christ, our Saviour. Amen.

**Amberg 1555: the confession in the plural.** The Amberg order of 1555 takes the Mecklenburg form for its Mass on feast days. Sehling's editor notes that the section is taken "ganz aus Mecklenburg 1552". But it changes the priest's confession from the singular to the plural, so that it is no longer "Ich armer sündiger mensch" but "Wir armen, sündige menschen". **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 13, p. 290):

> Erstlich soll der chor das Veni, Sancte, nachmals der priester in dem gewonligen ornat Adjutorium nostrum in nomine [Ps. 124,8] singen. Darauf respondir der chor Qui fecit celum et terram [Ps. 124,8]. Alsdann soll er sich vor dem altar gegen dem volk wenden und mit lauter stimm sprechen: Mein allerliebsten in Got! Eröffnet eure herzen, laßt uns vur Got unsere sunden bekennen und umb vergebung im namen unsers Herren Jesu Christi bitten! Sprecht mir nach mit herzligem begern zu Got im glauben an den Herren Jesum Cristum durch den Heiligen Geist! Dann knie der priester nider fur den altar und ein anderer kirchendiener neben ine und spreche mit lauter stimb: Wir armen, sündige menschen bekennen fur dir, o allmechtiger Got, unserm schöpfer und erlöser, daß wir gesundigt haben nicht allein mit gedanken worten und werken, sondern daß wir auch von natur sundig und verdamt sind, in sunden empfangen und geboren. Wir haben aber zuefluecht zu deiner grundlosen barmherzigkeit, suchen und begern gnad umb des Herren Jesu Christi willen. Herr, sei gnedig uns armen sundern! Der ander kierchendiener antwort dises gebet: O almechtiger, barmherziger Got, der du deinen eingebornen Sune fur uns in den tod gegeben hast! Wollest dich unser erbarmen und umb desselben deines geliebten Suns willen uns alle unsere sunde vergeben, auch deinen Heiligen Geist uns geben, der in uns wares erkentnus deines göttlichen wesens und willens, darzue waren gehorsam gegen dir anzunde, mehre und erhalte, uf daß wir das ebige leben durch dein gnad umb des Herren Jesu Christi willen erlangen! Amen. Der priester stee alsdann auf und spreche hernach diese absolution gegen dem volk und soll der ander kirchendiener alleweil kniend bleiben: Der almechtig, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet, vergibt uns warhaftiglich alle unsere sunde umb seines lieben Sons willen, den er umb unserentwillen hat in den tod gegeben, und hat macht gegeben, Gottes kinder zu werden, allen, die an seinen namen glauben, gibt uns darzue seinen Heiligen Geist. Wer glaubt und getauft wierd, soll selig werden. Das verleihe uns Got allen! Amen. Und, alldieweil dise peicht, gebet und absolution gesprochen wird, soll die ganze kirchen still sein und solchs anhören, auch mit dem priester also bekennen, beten und die absolution zu herzen fassen, wol lernen und fur Got oft desgleichen sprechen.

First shall the choir sing the *Veni, Sancte*, and afterward the priest, in the accustomed vestment, *Adjutorium nostrum in nomine* [Ps 124:8]. Thereupon the choir respondeth *Qui fecit celum et terram* [Ps 124:8]. Then shall he turn before the altar toward the people and say with a loud voice: My dearly beloved in God! Open your hearts, let us confess our sins before God and pray for forgiveness in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ! Say after me with hearty desire unto God, in faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, through the Holy Ghost! Then let the priest kneel down before the altar, and another minister of the church beside him, and say with a loud voice: We poor, sinful men confess before thee, O almighty God, our Creator and Redeemer, that we have sinned not only with thoughts, words and works, but that we are also by nature sinful and damned, conceived and born in sins. But we

have refuge unto thy bottomless mercy, and seek and desire grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake. Lord, be merciful to us poor sinners! The other minister of the church answereth this prayer: O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us! Vouchsafe to have mercy upon us, and for the sake of the same, thy beloved Son, forgive us all our sins, and give us also thy Holy Ghost, who may kindle, increase and preserve in us true knowledge of thy divine being and will, and thereto true obedience toward thee, that we may obtain eternal life through thy grace, for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake! Amen. Let the priest then stand up and thereafter speak this absolution toward the people, and the other minister of the church shall remain kneeling the while: The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, forgiveth us truly all our sins for his dear Son's sake, whom for our sakes he hath given unto death, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name, and giveth us moreover his Holy Ghost. He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. God grant this unto us all! Amen. And while this confession, prayer and absolution are spoken, the whole church shall be still and hear it, and also with the priest so confess, pray and take the absolution to heart, learn it well, and often say the like before God.

**Note.** The plural confession and the instruction that the church shall "mit dem priester also bekennen" (with the priest so confess) bring Amberg nearer than any other sixteenth-century witness to the Common Service, whose confession begins "Almighty God, our Maker and Redeemer, we poor sinners confess unto Thee" (§3.4.5). Sehling's apparatus shows that the text it calls the *Bericht* reads "unrein" (unclean), as Mecklenburg does, where the order of 1555 has "verdamt" (damned).

**Hadeln: the confession sung, the sexton absolving.** The Hadeln order, which Sehling dates 1526, has the priest vest during the *Te Deum* at the end of Matins and kneel for *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. He then sings the confession on the same tone, and the sexton answers and reads the absolution. **Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung* "von 1526"** (Sehling 5, pp. 467–468):

> Under des dat men singet Te Deum, schal sick de prester kleden mit gewantlickem missgewant, nicht alse nödig, sundern als ein düchtig erbarlich zirath, und nicht darinne de saligkeit soken. Des gelicken schal men ein edder twe wasslichte ansticken (dewile idt des heren aventmahl ist), und up dem altare brennen laten, bet de misse uthe is. Wenn denn de collecta der metten gesungen ist, so schall de prester demödig up de knee sitten gahn, und singen mit dem chore Veni sancte spiritus latinisch edder dudesch. Finita collecta blifft de prester sitten, und hevet lude mit demsulvigen thono de confession an, und bi ehme de köster antwordet, und list de absolution. Alss den singet men einen psalmum vor dem Introitu de dominica edder trinitate edder de Spiritu sancto vel pasche, edder wat der schrift nicht tho weddern ist.

While the Te Deum is being sung, the priest shall clothe himself with the accustomed Mass vestment, not as needful, but as a seemly and honest ornament, and not seek salvation therein. Likewise one or two wax lights shall be lit (since it is the Lord's Supper) and be let burn upon the altar until the Mass is out. When then the collect of Matins hath been sung, the priest shall go humbly to kneel upon his knees and sing with the choir *Veni sancte spiritus* in Latin or German. The collect being ended, the priest remaineth kneeling and beginneth aloud the confession on the same tone, and the sexton by him answereth and readeth the absolution. Then a psalm is sung before the Introit, of the Sunday or of the Trinity or of the Holy Ghost or of Easter, or whatever is not contrary to Scripture.

**Note.** One manuscript (Sehling's VIII, 65) adds the remark: "Nb. dat Confiteor mit des costers absolution ist gefallen" (Nota bene: the Confiteor with the sexton's absolution has fallen [away]; Sehling 5, p. 468). The sexton's absolution was given up at some later date.

#### 3.3.5 Family D: the *Offene Schuld* moved into the Mass

**The *Offene Schuld*.** The late medieval *Offene Schuld* ("open guilt") was a general confession, with a declaratory absolution, recited by the preacher after the sermon in the vernacular preaching service. It was never part of the Mass. The first evangelical Masses carry it into the Mass, as an absolution of the communicants. Sehling's editor sets out the development under Volprecht 1524 (Sehling 11, p. 39):

> Wie schon die deutsche Messe des Kaspar Kantz in Nördlingen 1522 (Smend 74), die Straßburger deutsche Messe 1524 (Smend 126) und die Messe Döbers (siehe unten S. 57) nach mittelalterlichem Vorbild erst im Predigtgottesdienst (Surgant f. 84ff.), dann aber auch nach der Predigt im Meßgottesdienst (Jungmann 1, 631ff.). Bei diesem Übergang aus dem Predigtgottesdienst in die Messe wandelte sich aber, wie diese ihre Verwendung zeigt, die Offene Schuld für das Volksempfinden aus einem Predigtanhängsel in eine Rüsthandlung für den Sakramentsteil.

As already the German Mass of Kaspar Kantz in Nördlingen 1522, the Strasbourg German Mass 1524, and Döber's Mass, after the medieval model, first in the preaching service, but then also after the sermon in the Mass. In this passage out of the

preaching service into the Mass, however, the Open Confession was changed, as this use of it shows, in the feeling of the people from an appendage of the sermon into a preparation for the Sacrament.

**Kantz, Nördlingen 1522.** The earliest form opens with an exhortation, then gives the absolution with no confession text at all: "Der allmechtig, barmherzig Gott vergeb euch euer sünd! Und ich, us bevelch unsers Herren Jesu Christi an statt der heiligen kirchen, sag euch frei, ledig und los aller euer sünden …" (The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins! And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed of all your sins …; Sehling 12, p. 285). Sehling's editor calls it a fusion of the *Indulgentiam* with the absolution of private confession. The full text, with *Adiutorium* and the recast *Orate fratres*, is in Chapter 7 §7.2.1.

**Bremen 1525.** The Low German *Evangelische Misse* printed at Bremen in 1525 translates Kantz's address and absolution: "De almechtige, barmhertige Got vorgeve iw iwe sunde. Unde ick, uth bevel unses heren Jesu Christi, in de stede der hilligen kercken, vorkundige iw fry, ledich unde los to syn van al iwen sunden" (The almighty, merciful God forgive you your sins. And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, proclaim you to be free, quit and loosed of all your sins; Sehling 7/2.2, p. 405). It heads the priest's request for the people's prayer "Bicht des presters" (the priest's confession), and keeps Kantz's *Adiutorium* and *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. The address is printed in §3.5.14.1.

**Volprecht, Nürnberg 1524.** The prior of the Augustinians at Nürnberg says an *offene beicht* "anstatt des Confiteor" before the Introit, addressed to God and to "brothers and sisters". The absolution that follows is headed "Absolutio, das Misereatur". **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of the prior Volprecht, 1524** (Sehling 11, pp. 39–40):

> Wenn der briester will lesen ein teutsche meß, spricht er vor die offene beicht anstatt des Confiteor: Ich armer, elender, sündiger maensch bekenn mich Gott meinem himlischen Vater und meinem Herren Jesu Christo meinem seligmacher, euch brüder und schwester und der ganzen christlichen versamlung, das ich leider oft und dick wieder Gott, meinen Herrn, gesündigt hab mit unglauben und mißtrauen, in nit geliebt uber alle ding und meinen nechsten als mich selbes. Das ist mir vest und ser laid von grund meines herzens. O Herr Gott, allmechtiger Vater, ich armer sunder ermahn dich deiner gnadenreichen zusagung und versprechung, da du verheist vergebung der sund durch das blut deines Suns Jesu Christi, der fur uns gestorben ist und sein blut zu vergebung der sund fur uns vergossen hat. Derselbig mein Herr […] Jesus Christus hat auch durch sein heiligen mund gesprochen, wo zwen oder drei in seinern namen versamelt sein, da sei er in irer mitte, und, was sie von dir in seinem namen bitten, das sollen sie gewert sein. So bitten wir verzeihung unser sund in seinen namen. Herr Gott, sprich zu uns: Nach deinem glauben geschech dir! Gee hin in frid! Sundige nit meer! Deine sund sein dir vergeben, verziehen und nachgelassen. Absolutio, das Misereatur: Mein lieber bruder und schwester, Gott hat sich unser erbarmet und hat uns verzihen alle unser sund und will uns geben das ewig leben. Amen.

When the priest will read a German Mass, he saith beforehand the open confession instead of the Confiteor: I, poor, wretched, sinful man, confess myself unto God my heavenly Father and unto my Lord Jesus Christ my Saviour, unto you, brothers and sisters, and unto the whole Christian congregation, that I have, alas, often and much sinned against God my Lord with unbelief and mistrust, not loved him above all things, and my neighbour as myself. That is sore and grievous unto me from the bottom of my heart. O Lord God, almighty Father, I, a poor sinner, put thee in mind of thy gracious pledge and promise, wherein thou promisest forgiveness of sins through the blood of thy Son Jesus Christ, who died for us and shed his blood for us for the forgiveness of sins. The same my Lord Jesus Christ hath also spoken by his holy mouth: where two or three are gathered together in his name, there is he in the midst of them; and what they ask of thee in his name, that shall be granted them. So we pray for the pardon of our sins in his name. Lord God, say unto us: According to thy faith be it unto thee! Go in peace! Sin no more! Thy sins are forgiven, pardoned and remitted thee. Absolution, the Misereatur: My dear brother and sister, God hath had mercy upon us, and hath pardoned us all our sins, and will give us everlasting life. Amen.

**Note.**

- **"euch brüder und schwester"** keeps the *Confiteor*'s "et vobis, fratres" (and to you, brethren), with the saints left out.
- **The absolution** is in the first person plural ("unser", us), so the priest includes himself; it is a declaration, not a sentence of loosing.

**Naumburg 1537: an indicative absolution at the start of Mass.** At St. Wenzel's in Naumburg the choir sings *Kom heiliger geist herre gott*, and the priest then reads "das confiteor zum volk". It is a bidding to prayer, a confession said by all, and an absolution in the first person singular. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's, 1537** (Sehling 2, pp. 77–78):

> Darauf list der priester das confiteor zum volk wie volget. Lieben freunde, dieweil wir itzunt alle in dem dienst gottes des almechtigen zu hören sein heiliges gotliches wort vorsamlet sein, so wollen wir erstlichen den herrn umb seine gnade anrufen und bitten, das er uns unsere herzen zu dem warhaftigem Vorstand seines gütlichen Worts eröffnen wolle [...] Dieweil wir aber alle sunder sein, so last uns erstlichen unsere sunde bekennen und dieselben gott dem almechtigen abbitten und sprecht. Ich armer sunder bekenne dir o almechtiger gott und barmherziger vater fur dieser ganzen gemein alle meine sunde und missethat, dardurch ich dich so mannichfeltig zu zorn vorursacht und bit dich durch deine grundlose barmherzigkeit, und durch das bittere leiden und sterben deines lieben sohns JESU CHRISTI du wollest gnedig sein mir armen sundern. Absolutio. Auf solch euer bekentnus aus bevel des herrn Jesu Christi anstat der heiligen christlichen kirchen vorgebe ich euch all eure sunde im namen des vaters und des sons und des heiligen geistes. Amen. Der fried des herrn Jesu Christi sei mit euch allen. Amen. Hierauf singt der ganze chor das kyrie eleison

Thereupon the priest readeth the Confiteor to the people, as followeth. Dear friends, forasmuch as we are now all gathered in the service of God the almighty to hear his holy, godly word, we will first call upon the Lord for his grace and pray him that he would open our hearts to the true understanding of his divine word [...] But forasmuch as we are all sinners, let us first confess our sins and beg pardon for the same of God the almighty, and say: I, poor sinner, confess unto thee, O almighty God and merciful Father, before this whole congregation all my sins and misdeeds, whereby I have so manifoldly provoked thee to wrath; and I pray thee, through thy bottomless mercy and through the bitter passion and death of thy dear Son JESUS CHRIST, that thou wouldest be gracious to me, poor sinner. Absolution. Upon this your confession, by the command of the Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Christian Church, I forgive you all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. The peace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen. Thereupon the whole choir singeth the Kyrie eleison.

**Note.** "Auf solch euer bekentnus … anstat der heiligen christlichen kirchen vorgebe ich euch all eure sunde" is the formula of private confession, used here over the whole congregation. Compare the Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg prohibitions of a "gemeine beicht" (§3.4.6).

### 3.3.6 Family E: the Upper German and Reformed opening

In Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed, before the Interim) and the Reformed orders the service begins with the minister's call to confession, a prayer of confession in the first person plural, and a comfortable word as absolution. This is the *Offene Schuld* of the preaching service, kept at its head. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537/1541** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 270):

> Das Confiteor oder offene schuld: Bekennen Gott, dem Herren, und verjehen mitt mir ein jedes seine sünd und missethat: Almechtiger, ewiger Got und vatter, wir bekennen und verjehen dir, das wir inn ungerechtigkeiten empfangen, voller sünd und ubertrettung sein inn allem unserm leben, als die, so deinem wort nit volkomen glauben noch deinen heiligen gebotten nach kommen. Wir bitten dich, sihe an dein güte, und umb deins namens willen seie genedig und verzeihe unserer missethat, die leider gros ist. Ein absolution oder trostspruch, I. Timothei I: Das ist gewislich war unnd ein theur werdes wort: Christus Jesus ist kommen inn die welt, die sünder selig zu machen. Ein jedes bekenne sich in warheit mit dem H. Paulo in seinem hertzen und glaube inn Christum, so versprich ich euch in seinem namen verzeihung aller ewer sünden und sage euch derselbigen los auff erden, das ir iren auch im himel los seien in ewigkeit, Amen. Etwan nimet er andere sprüch, die uns der verzeihung der sünden unnd bezalung Christi für unsere sünd getrüsten, Als: Joannis am III.: Also hat Got die welt geliebt, das er seinen einigen Sun gab, auff das alle, die an in glauben, nit verloren werden, sondern das ewig leben haben.

The Confiteor or open confession: Confess unto God the Lord, and acknowledge with me, every one, his sins and misdeeds: Almighty, everlasting God and Father, we confess and acknowledge unto thee that we were conceived in iniquities, and are full of sin and transgression in all our life, as they that neither believe thy word perfectly nor follow thy holy commandments. We pray thee, look upon thy goodness, and for thy name's sake be gracious and pardon our misdeed, which, alas, is great. An absolution or comfortable word, 1 Timothy 1: This is a true saying and a precious word: Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners. Let every one confess himself in truth with Saint Paul in his heart, and believe in Christ; so I promise you in his name the pardon of all your sins, and pronounce you loosed of the same on earth, that ye may be loosed of them also in heaven for ever, Amen. Sometimes he taketh other sayings that comfort us with the pardon of sins and Christ's payment for our sins, as John 3: God so loved the world, that he gave his only Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.

**Note.**

- **The name.** "Das Confiteor oder offene schuld": in Strasbourg (1537, Moderate Reformed) the open confession *is* the *Confiteor*.
- **The absolution** is conditional on each one's confession and faith ("Ein jedes bekenne sich … und glaube … so versprich ich euch"). Further comfortable words follow: John 3:35–36, Acts 10:43 and 1 John 2:1–2 (p. 271).
- **A second Confiteor** follows: "Almechtiger, ewiger Gott und vatter, wir bekennen und verjehen, das wir leider in sünden empfangen und geboren sind unnd daher geneigt zu allem argen unnd treg zu allem guten …" (Almighty, everlasting God and Father, we confess and acknowledge that we were, alas, conceived and born in sins, and therefore inclined to all evil and slothful to all good …; p. 271). The Palatinate editor names this "other Confiteor" among the sources of the Palatinate prayer below.

**The Palatinate 1563** (Reformed). The Reformed order of Elector Frederick III opens the Sunday morning service with a prayer of confession before the sermon, and puts the confession, absolution and retention after the sermon (§3.4.4). The prayer before the sermon begins **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 388):

> Für der predig, insonderheyt an den Son- und feyertagen morgens und an bettagen, soll diß nachvolgend gebet dem volck fürgesprochen werden, in welchem die christlich gemein des menschhchen elendts außtrücklich erinnert und die heilsame gnade Gottes begert wirdt, auf daß die hertzen zur demut bereit werden und das wort der gnaden desto begierlicher annemen. Gnad, fried und barmhertzigkeyt etc. Himmlischer vater, ewiger und barmhertziger Gott, wir bekennen und verjehen für deiner göttlichen majestet, daß wir arme, elende sünder seind, empfangen und geboren in aller boßheyt und verderbnuß, geneigt zu allem bösen, unnütz zu einigem guten, und daß wir mit unserm sündlichen leben ohne underlaß deine heilige gebot ubertreten

Before the sermon, especially on Sundays and holy days in the morning, and on days of prayer, this following prayer shall be spoken before the people, wherein the Christian congregation is expressly reminded of man's misery, and the wholesome grace of God is desired, to the end that hearts may be made ready unto humility and receive the word of grace the more desirously. Grace, peace and mercy, etc. Heavenly Father, eternal and merciful God, we confess and acknowledge before thy divine majesty that we are poor, wretched sinners, conceived and born in all wickedness and corruption, inclined to all evil, unprofitable to any good, and that with our sinful life we transgress thy holy commandments without ceasing

**Note.**

- **The opening** is the apostolic greeting "Gnad, fried und barmhertzigkeyt" (Grace, peace and mercy) in the place of the versicles. The prayer ends with the Our Father (p. 389).
- **The editor** traces the prayer to Geneva 1563 and Frankfurt 1555 (both Reformed) and "Straßburg … (das andere Confiteor)", the second Strasbourg confession above (Moderate Reformed).
- **Poullain and Micron** (both Reformed). The French stranger church at Frankfurt opens with *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* and a *Confessio peccatorum*, "Domine Deus, Pater aeterne …" (Sehling 9, p. 563). Micron's Dutch order for London, also used at Emden, has an open confession with a conditional declaration (Sehling 7/1, p. 602).

**Wertheim 1524: the confession after the sermon.** The earliest report of a Mass after the sermon is Franz Kolb's letter to Luther. **Wertheim, Franz Kolb to Luther, 27 August 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 707):

> primum convenimus omnes ad concionem; facta concione, statim omissis ornatibus huc usque usitatis, paratis pane et vino, flexis ante altare genubus, alta et teutonica voce dico Confiteor brevissimum, deinde Pater noster, pro tertio Credo in Deum; statim surgo, consecro panem nudis Christi verbis et calicem, et sine omni adhortatione communico fratrem meum capellanum cum aliis fratribus et sororibus.

First we all come together to the sermon; the sermon being done, straightway, the ornaments hitherto used being laid aside, bread and wine being made ready, with knees bowed before the altar, I say with a loud voice and in German a very short Confiteor, then the Pater noster, thirdly the Credo in Deum; straightway I rise, consecrate the bread with the bare words of Christ, and the cup, and without any exhortation communicate my brother the chaplain with the other brethren and sisters.

### 3.3.7 Family F: a hymn, a psalm or *Veni Sancte Spiritus* at the beginning

**Luther.** The *Formula missae* (1523) begins with the Introit. The *Deutsche Messe* (1526) begins with a German hymn or psalm, followed directly by the Kyrie. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Zum anfang aber singen wir ein geistlich lied oder einen deudschen psalmen in primo tono auf die weise wie folget. „Ich will den Herrn loben alle zeit." (Psalm 34, 1 —23). Darauf kyrie eleison, auch im selben thon, drei mal und nicht neun mal

But at the beginning we sing a spiritual song or a German psalm in the first tone, after the manner as followeth: "I will bless the Lord at all times" (Psalm 34:1–23). Thereupon Kyrie eleison, also in the same tone, three times and not nine times.

Luther's Mass has no confession and no versicles before the Introit or the opening psalm.

**The Holy Ghost before the Introit.** Several orders recast the medieval *accessus* as a congregational preparation of the Holy Ghost. At the Amberg hospital church the schoolmaster and boys sing *Veni Sancte*, and the priest sings a German collect with the versicle. **Amberg, *Ordnung der kirchen … im spital*, 1544** (Sehling 13, p. 282):

> Zum ersten, soe der priester in seinem habitu nach altem gebrauch der kirchen uber den altar tritt, singt unser schulmeister mit den knaben das lateinisch Veni, Sancte..., darauf der priester ein deutsche collecten sampt dem versikel, umb gnad des Hailigen Gaistes bittende. Nachmals singt der chor den introitum missae de S[ancta] Trinitate oder sonst de tempore

First, when the priest in his habit, according to the old use of the church, goeth up to the altar, our schoolmaster singeth with the boys the Latin *Veni, Sancte* …; thereupon the priest a German collect together with the versicle, praying for the grace of the Holy Ghost. Afterward the choir singeth the Introit of the Mass of the Holy Trinity, or else *de tempore*.

**Editor's note** (p. 282). This is "eine Rüsthandlung für die Gemeinde anstatt des Stufengebetes (mit dem Confiteor)" (a preparation for the congregation in place of the prayers at the foot of the altar, with the Confiteor), probably a form of the *accessus*. The note is quoted in full in §3.6.1. The collect is presumably the Pentecost collect *Deus, qui corda fidelium*, and the versicle *Cor mundum crea in me, Deus*, which Luther used at his ordinations (WA 38, 424).

At Verden the choir sings *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, the priest sings *Emitte Spiritum tuum*, and the collect *Deus, qui corda fidelium* follows. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 155–156):

> Erstlich, wann der priester oder pfarrer vor den altar getretten, so soll der chor die antiphen Veni, sancte Spiritus anfahen. Darnach soll der priester singen: Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur. Der chor soll antworten: Et renovabis faciem terrae […] Ferner soll der priester singen: Oremus. Deus, qui corda fidelium. Darauf soll der introitus de tempore, Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis Deo, item Et in terra pax gesungen werden

First, when the priest or pastor hath stepped before the altar, the choir shall begin the antiphon *Veni, sancte Spiritus*. Thereafter the priest shall sing: *Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur*. The choir shall answer: *Et renovabis faciem terrae* […] Further the priest shall sing: *Oremus. Deus, qui corda fidelium*. Thereupon shall be sung the Introit *de tempore*, Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis Deo, and Et in terra pax.

**Editor's note** (p. 155): "Unsere Liturgie bis zum Introitus ist eine 'praeparatio ad missam'. Im späteren Mittelalter hatte man aus dem privaten priesterlichen Vorbereitungsoffizium (Akzeß) manchmal eine Hore der Kleriker und gleichsam ein 'officium de Spiritu sancto' gestaltet" (Our liturgy up to the Introit is a *praeparatio ad missam*. In the later Middle Ages the private preparatory office of the priest, the *accessus*, had sometimes been made into an hour of the clergy, as it were an "office of the Holy Ghost").

The same pattern stands in other orders:

- **Kantz 1522** and **Döber 1525**: *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, said by the priest for the people after the absolution (§3.3.4).
- **Buxtehude 1552**: on weekdays a German psalm before the Introit, "alse Kum, hilliger Geist" (Sehling 7/1, p. 74).
- **Naumburg 1537**, **Nördlingen 1544**, **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557** and **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574**: *Kom heiliger geist herre gott* or *Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist*, sung by the choir or congregation, at Pfalz-Veldenz kneeling.
- **Hadeln**: *Veni sancte spiritus*, priest kneeling with the choir (§3.3.4).
- **Hof 1592**: *Veni Sancte Spiritus* "ante introitum" at the Monday office in the monastery church, sung in three parts (Sehling 11, p. 464).

**The Benedictus at Hermannstadt.** The Transylvanian order sings Zechariah's canticle in German before the Introit on Sundays, in place of the abolished procession. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547, Latin version** (Sehling 24, p. 223):

> Dominicis diebus pro abrogato circuitu, ante Introitum, canitur Germanicum canticum Zachariae: Benedictus Dominus aut si quibus magis tunc placeant litaniae, tempore Paschali: Salve festa dies. Aliis diebus festis haec praetermittimus, initium missae sumentes ab introitu de tempore aut alio simili, si non repugnet scripturae.

On Sundays, in place of the abolished procession, before the Introit, there is sung in German the canticle of Zacharias, *Benedictus Dominus*; or, if the litany please any better at that time; in Eastertide, *Salve festa dies*. On other feast days we leave these out, taking the beginning of the Mass from the Introit *de tempore* or another like it, if it be not contrary to Scripture.

**In the villages.** Where there was no Latin choir, a German psalm or hymn stood in place of the Introit:

- Mecklenburg 1540: "Up den dörperen schal men stedes einen düdeschen psalm singen vor den introitum" (in the villages a German psalm shall always be sung before the Introit; Sehling 5, p. 151).
- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533: "ein christenlich teutsch gesang" (§3.3.2).
- Sayn 1590: "Erstlich, wann man in die Kirche kompt, soll man einen Teutschen Psalm singen. Darnach soll der Pfarrherr ein Collect lesen" (First, when one cometh into the church, a German psalm shall be sung; thereafter the pastor shall read a collect; Sehling 19/1, p. 412).

### 3.3.8 Family G: Müntzer's Allstedt Mass; *Iudica me* and *Aufer a nobis* elsewhere

**Müntzer keeps the *Stufengebet*.** Thomas Müntzer's German Masses (Radical Reformation) for Allstedt are the one place in Sehling where Ps 43 *Iudica me* survives as the preparation for Mass. In the order of 1523 the Mass begins "So man zuvorn vorm altar gemeine beicht thut" (when the general confession has first been made before the altar; Sehling 1, p. 504). The *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* of 1524 prints it. Ps 43 (the Vulgate's 42nd) is said by the priest and the whole people; it includes, as its fourth verse, the *Introibo ad altare Dei* that the Roman Mass uses as its antiphon. Then come the priest's confession, the people's *Misereatur*, the versicle *Deus, tu conversus*, and the prayer *Aufer a nobis*, all in German, all aloud, and all before the Introit.
**Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 499):

> Ampt von der menschwerdung Christi unsers heilandes. Der 42. psalm wird gesprochen mit dem ganzen volk, ehe man gemeine beicht thut. 1. O got, urteil mich und sunder mich ab von der gottlosen art, und errette mich von dem hinterlistigen schalke. 2. Dan du bist ein gott meiner sterke. Warumb hast du mich vorlassen? Ich ging wie ein trauriger, do mich zwang der gottlose mensche. 3. Schick aus dein licht und warheit, dass sie werden mich furen zum heiligen berge und deinem lager. 4. Do werde ich kommen zum altar gottis, zu gotte, der meine jugent erfrauet. O gott, mein gott, do bekenne ich dein lob auf der harfen. 5. O meine seele, warumb rimpfestu dich? warumb machstu mich traurig? erwarte des herrn; dann ich bekenn ihn. Er ist ein heil meins angesichts, und er ist mein gott. 6. Ere sei dem vater und dem sone und dem heiligen geiste. Als es war im anfang, itzt und immer und von ewickeit zu ewickeit. — Do antwort das gemein volk: Amen. Die beicht thut der priester mit klaren worten vor allem volk, sagende: O milder gott vater, ich bekenne dir und deinem zarten sohne, Jesu Christ, und dem tröster, dem heiligen geist, vor allen gottfürchtigen, das ich elender sunder mein lebenlang wider deinen willen (der durchs gesetz erklert wirt) gehandelt habe, mit hinlessigem zuvorsicht und mit ungeübtem glauben und mit unbeflissner liebe stat gegeben hab den sunden; dieselbigen mit begir, worten und werken nit abgewant durch gottis werk und wort. Darumb bit ich euch umbstehenden auserwelten freunde gottis helfen zu bitten vor mich mit ganzem herzen, gemüt und kreften, auf das die geheim göttliches bundes eröffnet werden durch meine rede und durch eur gehöre. Das gemeine volk sagt darauf: Got sei dir gnedig, lere dich von tag zu tage, alle seines willens und werks uns zu gute warnemen mit thun und lassen. Der priester sagt darauf: Amen. Und sobald saget er diesen vers: O gott, wende dich zu uns wie ein getreuer unterweiser. Do antwort das volk darauf: Auf das wir, dein volk, mügen in dir frölich sein. Darnach saget der priester: O herr, nicht uns, nicht uns. Resp.: Sundern gib den preis deinem namen. Der priester saget: Last uns bitten: O herr, nimm von uns unser missethat, das wir mit rechtschaffenem gemüt deiner heiligen göttlichen kraft mügen gewertig sein im gezeugnis zukünftiger wort durch Jesum Christum, unsern herrn. Amen.

The Office of the Incarnation of Christ our Saviour. The 42nd psalm is said with the whole people, before the general confession is made. 1. O God, judge me and sever me from the ungodly kind, and deliver me from the deceitful knave. 2. For thou art the God of my strength. Why hast thou forsaken me? I went as one that mourneth, when the ungodly man oppressed me. 3. Send out thy light and truth, that they may lead me to the holy hill and to thy dwelling. 4. There will I come to the altar of God, to God, who maketh glad my youth. O God, my God, there will I confess thy praise upon the harp. 5. O my soul, why art thou cast down? Why makest thou me sad? Wait for the Lord; for I confess him. He is the health of my countenance, and he is my God. 6. Glory be to the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost. As it was in the beginning, is now and ever, and from eternity to

eternity. Then the common people answer: Amen. The priest maketh the confession with clear words before all the people, saying: O mild God, Father, I confess to thee and to thy tender Son, Jesus Christ, and to the Comforter, the Holy Ghost, before all them that fear God, that I, a wretched sinner, have all my life long done against thy will (which is declared by the law), and with negligent confidence, unexercised faith and unstudious love have given place to sins, and have not turned them away in desire, words and works through God's work and word. Therefore I pray you, the chosen friends of God that stand about, to help to pray for me with all your heart, mind and strength, that the secret of the divine covenant may be opened through my speech and through your hearing. The common people saith thereupon: God be gracious unto thee, and teach thee from day to day to heed all his will and work for our good, in doing and in leaving undone. The priest saith thereupon: Amen. And straightway he saith this verse: O God, turn thee unto us as a faithful instructor. The people answer thereupon: That we, thy people, may be joyful in thee. Thereafter the priest saith: O Lord, not unto us, not unto us. Answer: But give the glory unto thy name. The priest saith: Let us pray: O Lord, take from us our iniquity, that with an upright mind we may wait upon thy holy, divine power in the witness of the words to come, through Jesus Christ, our Lord. Amen.

**What Müntzer keeps, and what he changes.**

| **Roman *Stufengebet*** | **Müntzer 1524** |
|---|---|
| *Introibo ad altare Dei* (antiphon) | Not said as an antiphon; kept only as verse 4 of the psalm, "Do werde ich kommen zum altar gottis" |
| Ps 43 *Iudica me*, priest and server in alternation, with *Gloria Patri* | Ps 43 in German, "mit dem ganzen volk", with *Gloria Patri*; the people answer *Amen* |
| *Adiutorium nostrum* | Not present |
| *Confiteor* of the priest, asking the bystanders to pray for him | A new confession by the priest "vor allem volk", asking "euch umbstehenden auserwelten freunde gottis" to pray for him |
| *Misereatur* of the server | "Got sei dir gnedig, lere dich von tag zu tage …", said by the people |
| *Confiteor* of the server and the priest's *Misereatur* and *Indulgentiam* | Not present; there is no absolution |
| *Deus, tu conversus vivificabis nos* / *Et plebs tua laetabitur in te* | "O gott, wende dich zu uns wie ein getreuer unterweiser" / "Auf das wir, dein volk, mügen in dir frölich sein" |
| (not in the Roman form) | "O herr, nicht uns, nicht uns" / "Sundern gib den preis deinem namen" (Ps 115:1) |
| *Aufer a nobis* | "O herr, nimm von uns unser missethat …", recast to look forward to the "zukünftiger wort" (words to come) |

The Roman versicles *Ostende nobis* and *Domine, exaudi*, the *Dominus vobiscum* and *Oramus te* are gone. The server's part has passed to the whole congregation.

**Elsewhere, *Aufer a nobis* alone.** Outside Allstedt the prayer *Aufer a nobis* appears in one order for certain, and in another by the editor's conjecture:

- **The *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545** sing it in Latin after the sermon, as the first of three verses during which the people kneel and pray "an stadt des offertorii" (in place of the offertory). Its petition to enter "ad sancta sanctorum" (into the holy of holies) here leads into the Preface. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 300):

> Nach der predigt. Sal man erstlich das dominus vobiscum singen, darnach dise drei versus anheben. 1 Aufer a nobis domine cunctas iniquitates nostras, ut mereamur puris mentibus introire ad sancta sanctorum. Alleluja. 2 Miserere, miserere, miserere, populo tuo quem redemisti, Christe, sanguine tuo ne in eternum irascaris nobis. Alleluja. 3 Exaudi, exaudi, exaudi, domine, preces nostras o Jesu Christe, intercede pro nobis Alleluja.

After the sermon. One shall first sing the *Dominus vobiscum*, and thereafter begin these three verses. 1. Take away from us, O Lord, all our iniquities, that we may be worthy to enter with pure minds into the holy of holies. Alleluia. 2. Have mercy, have

mercy, have mercy upon thy people, whom thou hast redeemed, O Christ, with thy blood, that thou be not angry with us for ever. Alleluia. 3. Hear, hear, hear, O Lord, our prayers, O Jesus Christ; make intercession for us. Alleluia.

- **Regensburg 1542.** During the litany, before the Introit, "betet der priester sambt dem evangelier das Confiteor" (the priest, together with the gospeller, prayeth the *Confiteor*); after the litany the priest sings "ein collecten anstat der ganzen kirchen" (a collect in the name of the whole church; Sehling 13, pp. 391–392). Sehling's editor takes this collect to be "Wohl das Gebet Aufer a nobis der Messe, nicht mehr aber das evangelisch unmögliche sich daran anschließende Oramus te" (probably the prayer *Aufer a nobis* of the Mass, but no longer the *Oramus te* that follows it, which was impossible for evangelicals). He adds that of the south German orders only Regensburg kept a prayer at this place, apart from the early Amberg form (Sehling 13, p. 392); but at Amberg 1550 he judges the collect "Kaum das noch zum Confiteor gehörige Gebet Aufer a nobis" (hardly the prayer *Aufer a nobis* that still belongs to the *Confiteor*; Sehling 13, p. 285).

**The Mass form of the *Confiteor*.** On Regensburg 1542 the editor also notes that Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* of 1543 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 knew "nur ein vom Geistlichen allein gesprochenes 'Confiteor oder was ine sein andacht erinnert'" (only a "Confiteor, or what his devotion bids him", said by the clergyman alone), whereas Regensburg's priest says it with the deacon; and that "In ähnlicher Weise wie in Regensburg wurde aber das Meß-Confiteor auch 1544 in Nördlingen (Sehling 12, 311) gebraucht" (in a similar way as at Regensburg, however, the Mass *Confiteor* was also used in 1544 at Nördlingen; Sehling 13, p. 391). For Nördlingen see §3.3.2.

**The verdict.** *Introibo* as an antiphon and Ps 43 as the priest's preparatory psalm disappear from every order in Sehling except Müntzer's (Radical Reformation). *Aufer a nobis* survives at the beginning of Mass only at Allstedt and, if the editor is right, at Regensburg 1542; in the *Cellische Ordnungen* it moves to the offertory. Ps 43 itself remains in the Lutheran orders as the Introit of Judica Sunday (e.g. Nördlingen 1579, Sehling 12, p. 379).

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## 3.4 Confession and absolution: what the orders did with the *Confiteor*

### 3.4.1 Where it falls

The confession of sins stands in four different places in the orders, and a few orders have it in two:

| Place | Form | Orders |
|---|---|---|
| **Before the Introit, privately** | The priest's *Confiteor* or other prayer at the altar, during the Introit | Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1542 and 1553, Amberg 1550, Buxtehude 1552, Bergedorf 1544, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Nördlingen 1544; Bugenhagen's kneeling prayer at Wolfenbüttel 1543 and Hildesheim 1544 (§§3.3.2–3.3.3) |
| **Before the Introit, publicly** | Address, confession and absolution in the people's hearing | Müntzer 1523/1524 (Radical Reformation; with Ps 43, no absolution; §3.3.8); Volprecht 1524, Döber 1525, Lippe, Kiel, Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, Amberg 1555, Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1544, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hadeln; Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; prayer before the sermon) (§§3.3.4–3.3.6) |
| **After the sermon** | Open confession from the pulpit, or at the altar before the Sacrament | Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528; Wertheim 1524 (§3.3.6); Kurpfalz 1556; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed); Amberg 1550 (§3.4.4) |
| **In the communion rite** | Confession and absolution after the exhortation, before the Verba | Kantz 1522 and Bremen 1525; Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed; the absolution inside the second exhortation); Regensburg c. 1544 and 1567; Hohenlohe 1553 (from the pulpit); Württemberg 1536 and its followers, among them Kurpfalz 1556 and Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573; Nürnberg after 1569; Mecklenburg 1552 (the absolution inside the exhortation); Marienhafe 1593 (a prayer of confession without absolution) (§§3.4.4, 3.5) |

**Mecklenburg 1552** has it twice: the public confession at the beginning of every Mass (§3.3.4), and an absolution inside the exhortation before communion (§3.5.9). **Nördlingen 1544** has it twice at the beginning: the celebrant's own *Confiteor*, absolved

by a fellow minister, and then the open confession to the people (§3.3.2).

**The Palatinate** moves it. Kurpfalz 1556 sets the order "die predigt, offen beicht und gemeines gebet" (the sermon, open confession and common prayer; Sehling 14, p. 165). In 1563, now Reformed, the confession and absolution follow the Sunday morning sermon, and the Supper has its own examination by questions (§3.4.4).

#### 3.4.2 Who says it, and does the chancel party pray it together?

- **The priest alone.** In family A the priest says the *Confiteor* by himself at the altar, silently or "by sick" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Hohenlohe 1553, Amberg 1550, Schleswig-Holstein 1542).
- **The priest and the ministrants.** Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 have the priest go to the altar "samt seinen ministranten". At Regensburg 1553 the priest prays the *Confiteor* kneeling with "dem einen ministranten (der dazumal secundus ist)", that is, in the Roman dialogue with the server.
- **The priest and the sexton.** In the north the sexton is the server:
  - Bugenhagen's prayer is said by the priest kneeling "mit dem köster" (Wolfenbüttel) or "mit dem oppermanne" (Hildesheim), who answers each versicle.
  - In Mecklenburg 1540 the sexton "edder ein ander christen" (or another Christian) kneels with the priest and says the prayer for forgiveness.
  - At Kiel the sexton reads the *Misereatur* and the absolution, and the priest says "Amen".
  - At Hadeln the sexton answers the priest's sung confession and reads the absolution. One manuscript notes that this "ist gefallen" (has been given up).
- **The priest and a second minister.** Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557: "ein ander kirchendiener oder custos" (another minister of the church, or the custos) kneels beside the priest; "der ander diener" says the prayer for forgiveness; the choir answers *Adiutorium*. At Nördlingen 1544 a fellow minister absolves the celebrant.
- **The people.** The people take one of four parts:
  - They say it **after the priest**: "sprecht mir nach" (say after me; Döber 1525) and "spreket de bicht mit my" (say the confession with me; Bugenhagen 1528).
  - They **confess silently** with him: Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552, "sol die ganze kirch stille sein … auch mit dem priester also bekennen" (the whole church shall be still … and also confess likewise with the priest).
  - They **confess in their hearts**: Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed), "Ein jedes bekenne sich … in seinem hertzen" (let every one confess himself … in his heart).
  - They **answer "Ja"** to questions: Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; §3.4.4).

**Is it done privately before Mass?** In two senses, yes:

- **The priest.** His *Confiteor* (family A) is private, but it is said at the altar at the beginning of Mass, not in the sacristy beforehand.
- **The communicants.** The usual Lutheran preparation was not a general confession at all, but each communicant's private confession, examination and absolution on the Saturday or before the service. The general confession was never allowed to replace it in Brandenburg (§3.4.6; the private rite is treated in Chapter 13 §13.17).

#### 3.4.3 Old texts or new?

**The Latin *Confiteor*.** No evangelical order in Sehling prints the Roman *Confiteor*. Where it is kept it is the priest's private prayer, and the text is assumed (§3.3.2). Hohenlohe 1553 wants "das reine Confiteor lateinisch" (the pure Confiteor in Latin); Brandenburg-Nürnberg allows "das Confiteor oder, was ine sein andacht erinnert" (the Confiteor, or what his devotion puts him in mind of).

**New confessions.** Every public confession in the corpus is a new text. There are five families of wording:

| Family | Incipit | Orders |
|---|---|---|
| Döber–Mecklenburg | "Und ich armer, sündiger mensch bekenn Got dem allmechtigen, meinem schöpfer und erlöser, das ich nit allein gesündiget hab mit gedanken, worten oder werken …" | Döber 1525, Lippe, Kiel, Mecklenburg 1540, 1552, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 |

| Family | Incipit | Orders |
|---|---|---|
| Volprecht | "Ich armer, elender, sündiger maensch bekenn mich Gott meinem himlischen Vater … euch brüder und schwester …" | Volprecht 1524 |
| Naumburg | "Ich armer sunder bekenne dir o almechtiger gott und barmherziger vater fur dieser ganzen gemein alle meine sunde und missethat …" | Naumburg 1537 |
| Württemberg | "Ich armer sünder bekenn mich Gott, meinem himelischen vatter, das ich leider schwerlich und manigfalt gesündet hab, nit allein mit eusserlichen, groben sünden, sonder vil mer mit innerlicher angeborner plindtheit …" | Württemberg 1536; Kurpfalz 1556; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; in the second person, "für dir, meinem Gott und schöpfer") |
| Strasbourg | "Almechtiger, ewiger Got und vatter, wir bekennen und verjehen dir, das wir inn ungerechtigkeiten empfangen …" | Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; prayer before the sermon); Poullain and Micron (Reformed) |

Bugenhagen's Brunswick confession of 1528 is a sixth, unique form: a confession against the Creed and the two tables of the law, with a pause for each to name his own sin (§3.4.4).

**The confession's two points.** The Döber family confesses actual sin "mit gedanken, worten oder werken" (in thoughts, words or works: the *cogitatione, verbo et opere* of the *Confiteor*) *and* original sin, "in sünden empfangen und geborn" (conceived and born in sins). Württemberg confesses "innerlicher angeborner plindtheit, unglauben, zweifelung" (inward inborn blindness, unbelief, doubt). Both make original sin and unbelief the matter of the confession.

**What became of the *Misereatur*.** The Roman *Misereatur tui omnipotens Deus* ("Almighty God have mercy upon thee") is said by the server for the priest and by the priest for the server. In the orders:

- **Kept by name.** At Kiel: "Minister legit: Myseriator. De coster list: Miseriator" (the minister reads the Misereatur; the sexton reads the Misereatur). The text is not given.
- **Recast as a prayer for us all.** Döber: "Der barmherzig Got wöl sich unser erbarmen …" (The merciful God vouchsafe to have mercy upon us …). Lippe heads this same prayer "De absolutio".
- **Given to the second minister.** In Mecklenburg 1540 "De dener antwerdet dit gebet" (the minister answereth this prayer), as the server answered the priest's *Confiteor* with the *Misereatur*. In 1552 it becomes a full collect, "O allmechtiger barmherziger gott, der du deinen eingebornen son für uns in den tod gegeben hast, wollest dich unser erbarmen …" (O almighty, merciful God, who hast given thine only-begotten Son unto death for us, vouchsafe to have mercy upon us …).
- **The name given to a declaration.** Volprecht heads his absolution "Absolutio, das Misereatur" (§3.3.5).

**What became of the *Indulgentiam*.** The Roman *Indulgentiam, absolutionem et remissionem peccatorum nostrorum tribuat nobis omnipotens et misericors Dominus* is a wish in the first person plural. Two orders keep its opening words:

- **Kantz 1522**: "Der allmechtig, barmherzig Gott vergeb euch euer sünd!" (The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins!), in the second person, followed by the indicative absolution.
- **Döber 1525**: "Der almechtich, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet …" (The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us …), recast as a declaration in the perfect tense.

#### 3.4.4 Optative, declaratory or indicative?

The absolutions fall into five types. The modern Common Service declaration of grace is type 2.

| Type | Formula | Orders |
|---|---|---|
| **1. Optative** (a wish or prayer) | "Der barmherzig Got wöl sich unser erbarmen und uns unsere sünd verzeihen …" (vouchsafe to have mercy upon us and forgive us) | Döber 1525 (the *Misereatur*); Lippe and Kiel; Mecklenburg 1540; Mecklenburg 1552 and Pfalz- |

| Type | Formula | Orders |
|---|---|---|
| | | Zweibrücken 1557 (as the second minister's prayer) |
| **2. Declaration of grace** (first person plural, no "I") | "Der almechtich, barmherzig Got hat sich unser erbarmet … Das verleihe uns Got allen" (hath had mercy upon us … God grant this unto us all) | Döber 1525; Mecklenburg 1540 and 1552; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Pfalz-Veldenz 1574; Volprecht 1524 ("Gott hat sich unser erbarmet") |
| **3. Indicative** (the minister, by Christ's command, looses) | "ich, us bevelch unsers Herren Jesu Christi an statt der heiligen kirchen, sag euch frei, ledig und los" (I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed) | Kantz 1522; Kiel (read by the sexton); Naumburg 1537; Württemberg 1536; Nürnberg after 1569; Mecklenburg 1552 (in the exhortation) |
| **4. Conditional declaration, with retention** | "Sovil nun euer sein, die … denselbigen … verkündige ich … Soviel aber under euch seind, die noch einen gefallen haben an iren sünden …" (As many of you as … to them I declare … But as many among you as still have pleasure in their sins …) | Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed; without retention); Micron and Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) |
| **5. No absolution**, only a word of comfort | "Jesus Christus is unse salicheit ewichlick" (Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever) | Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; Supper examination) |

**Type 2 and type 3.** The declaration of grace (type 2) is the commonest form at the *beginning* of the Mass. The indicative (type 3) is the commonest form in the *communion rite*, where it comes out of private confession. The orders do not argue over the difference. Württemberg 1536 offers both, and in the second person singular.

**Württemberg 1536: the open confession and three absolutions.** After the exhortation the pastor says the confession for all, then one of three absolutions; the congregation then sings the Our Father "als ein offenlich beicht" (as a public confession). **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, pp. 108–109):

> Nach der vermanung soll er inen vorsagen die offenliche beicht unnd nachvolgends die offenliche absolution, ungevarlich auff nachvolgende weis: Ich armer sünder bekenn mich Gott, meinem himelischen vatter, das ich leider schwerlich und manigfalt gesündet hab, nit allein mit eusserlichen, groben sünden, sonder vil mer mit innerlicher angeborner plindtheit, unglauben, zweifelung, kleinmütigkeit, ungedult, hochfart, bösen lüsten, heimlichen neyd unnd hass, mißvergünstig etc., wie das mein Herr Gott an mich erkendt und ich leider so volnkommenlich nit erkennen kan, also rewen sie mich und seind mir leid, beger gnad von Gott. Absolutio: Der allmechtig Got hat sich dein erbarmet und durch verdienst des allerheiligsten leidens, sterbens und aufferstehns unsers Herren Jesu Christi, seines geliebten suns, vergibt er dir all dein sünd, unnd ich, als ein verordneter diener der Christenlichen kirchen, verkündige dir aus bevelch unsers Herren Jesu Christi solche vergebung aller deiner sünd in namen des vatters und des suns und des heyligen geists, Amen. Gee hin im frid, dir geschech, wie du glaubest. Oder also: Der allmechtig und barmhertzig Gott vergibt dir dein sünd, und ich, aus bevelch unnsers Herren Jesu Christi, an stat der heiligen kirchen, sag dich frey, ledig und los aller deiner sünd in namen des vatters und des suns unnd des heiligen geists, Amen, Gee hin unnd sündige nicht mer, sonder besser dich one underlas; das helff dir Gott. Oder also: In der einsatzung des predig ampts des heiligen Evangelions hat Jesus Christus zu seinen Aposteln gesagt: Wer euch höret, der höret mich, und welchen ir die sünde erlassen, den seind sie erlassen, unnd welchen ir sie behaltet, den sind sie behalten. Aus vermög diser wort und bevelch Christi verkündige ich euch, das alle ewere sünd durch Jesum Christum gebüsset sein und erlasse euch als ein ordenlicher diener des heiligen Evangelions aller ewer mißthat in dem namen des vatters, des suns und des heiligen geists, Amen. Auff das singe die kirch das vatter unser teutsch, dieweil es ein sonderlich hertzlich gebett und auch darzu ein offenlich beicht ist.

After the exhortation he shall say before them the public confession, and afterward the public absolution, about after this manner: I, poor sinner, confess myself unto God my heavenly Father, that I have, alas, grievously and manifoldly sinned, not only with outward, gross sins, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faint-heartedness, impatience, pride, evil lusts, secret envy and hatred, grudging, etc., as my Lord God knoweth of me, and I, alas, cannot so perfectly know; therefore they repent me and are grievous unto me; I desire grace of God. Absolution: The almighty God hath had mercy upon thee, and

through the merit of the most holy passion, death and resurrection of our Lord Jesus Christ, his beloved Son, he forgiveth thee all thy sins; and I, as an appointed minister of the Christian Church, declare unto thee, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, such forgiveness of all thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Go in peace; be it unto thee as thou believest. Or thus: The almighty and merciful God forgiveth thee thy sin, and I, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce thee free, quit and loosed of all thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Go, and sin no more, but amend thyself without ceasing; God help thee thereto. Or thus: In the institution of the preaching office of the holy Gospel, Jesus Christ said to his apostles: He that heareth you heareth me; and whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted, and whose soever ye retain, they are retained. By virtue of these words and command of Christ I declare unto you that all your sins are atoned through Jesus Christ, and I remit you, as an ordained minister of the holy Gospel, all your misdeeds, in the name of the Father, of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, Amen. Thereupon let the church sing the Our Father in German, for it is a singularly hearty prayer, and therewith also a public confession.

**Note.**

- **The second person singular.** The first two absolutions are in the singular ("dir", thee), as in private confession. Sehling's editor refers both to the absolution of private confession in Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 187). Only the third is in the plural.
- **The confession** passes, almost word for word, into the Kurpfalz order of 1556 and from it into the Reformed Palatinate order of 1563 (below).
- **The Our Father** sung after the absolution is called "ein offenlich beicht" because of its fifth petition.

**Nürnberg after 1569: the *Offene Schuld* appended to the exhortation.** Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein*, in the editions from 1569, ends the exhortation with an invitation to confess and an absolution that is both conditional and indicative. **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, edition of 1569, from Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 11, p. 498):

> Und dieweil wir alle gesündiget haben und der genaden Gottes bedörfen, so demütiget eure herzen vor Gott dem Herren, bekennet eure sünde und gebrechen mit herzlicher lieb und begirde seiner götlichen gnaden und hilf, mit festem glauben und vertrauen auf sein genedig zusagen und vergebt von herzen ein jeder seinem nechsten, auf das euer himlischer Vater eure sünd und missetaten auch vergeb! So ir solches tut, entbind ich euch an stat der heiligen christlichen kirchen und aus befelch und zusagen unsers Herren Jesu Christi, da er sprach: „Weme ir die sünde vergebt, dem sein sie vergeben“ (Joh. 20, 23), von allen euren sünden im namen des Vaters und des Sons und des Heiligen Geistes. Amen.

And forasmuch as we have all sinned and have need of the grace of God, humble your hearts before God the Lord, confess your sins and infirmities with hearty love and desire of his divine grace and help, with firm faith and trust in his gracious promise, and forgive from the heart every one his neighbour, that your heavenly Father may also forgive your sins and misdeeds! If ye do this, I loose you, in the stead of the holy Christian Church and by the command and promise of our Lord Jesus Christ, when he said, "Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them" (John 20:23), from all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

**Editor's note** (p. 498, note 5). The *Offene Schuld* "war nach dem Vorbild mittelalterlicher Predigtgottesdienstformen … im Winter 1524/1525 … angefügt" (had been appended in the winter of 1524/25 on the model of the medieval preaching service). Osiander left it out when the exhortation was taken into the church order of 1533; "auf den Wunsch der Gemeinde" (at the congregation's wish) it was quickly taken back, and "Osiander führte jetzt gegen sie einen heißen, aber vergeblichen Kampf" (Osiander now waged a hot but vain battle against it). The wording disputed in 1533 came from Wenzel Linck.

**Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528: the confession from the pulpit.** After the sermon the preacher leads the people in the Creed and a confession of sins, without an absolution. The general prayer follows. **Brunswick, *Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 443):

> Exhortatio edder vormaninge up dem predickstole na der predige: Leven frunde in Christo, spreket mit my den loven. Ick love in Got den Vader, almechtigen etc. Spreket de bicht mit my unde bekennet Gade jue sunde, dat uns Got gnedich sy. Got sy gnedich my arme sunder. Id feylet my an deme loven, dat ick Got mynen Heren nicht van ganzeme herten leve, my nicht ganzlick up em vorlate in anvechtingen unde aller nöt lives unde der selen. Ick scholde alleyne Got fruchten unde in allen dingen vor ogene hebben, nu fruchte ick my vor de lüde, de my umme der gerechticheit willen konen bose dohn. Ick fruchte vor myn gut, ere, fruntschop unde lyff to vorlesende. Ick sorge vor de neringe unchristlick unde söke in

> allen dingen dat myne unde nicht, wat Gades is. Ock stelle ick nicht ganz myne salicheit in Jesum Christum, synen eyngebarn Sone, vor uns gegeven. Id feylet my ock an der leve, dat ick mynen negesten nicht leve alse my sulvest, sonder handele wedder en' mit bosen vordechtnissen, mit achterkosen, mit worden, mit werken unde kan nicht eyn wort van em wedder mick liden. Ick swige denne mehr unde kan em nicht van herten vorgeven unde bun doch sulcks schuldich to dohn. Besundergen hebbe ick eyne beswerde conscientie in disser anvechtinge: N., in disser sunden: N. (Eyn jewelick klage Gade syne heymelike beswerlike sunde tor beteringe). Darumme, almechtige Got, leve Vader, vorgiff my alle myne sunde unde erlüchte myn herte mit dyner warheit, dat ick dick: mach holden vor mynen gnedigen Vader unde mynen negesten vor mynen broder ane alle ergernisse nach dyneme worde dorch unsen Heren Jesum [...] Christum. (spreket:) Amen. Jesus Christus is unse salicheit ewichlick. (spreket:) Amen.

Exhortation or admonition on the pulpit after the sermon: Dear friends in Christ, say the Creed with me. I believe in God the Father almighty, etc. Say the confession with me, and confess your sins unto God, that God may be gracious unto us. God be merciful to me a poor sinner. I fail in faith, in that I love not God my Lord with my whole heart, nor rely wholly upon him in temptations and in all need of body and soul. I should fear God alone and have him before mine eyes in all things; now I fear the people that can do me evil for righteousness' sake. I fear to lose my goods, honour, friendship and life. I am careful for my living unchristianly, and seek in all things mine own and not what is God's. Also I set not my salvation wholly in Jesus Christ, his only-begotten Son, given for us. I fail also in love, in that I love not my neighbour as myself, but deal against him with evil suspicions, with backbiting, with words, with works, and cannot suffer one word from him against me. Much more I keep silence, and cannot forgive him from the heart, and yet am bound so to do. In especial I have a burdened conscience in this temptation: N., in this sin: N. (Let every one complain to God of his secret grievous sin, for amendment.) Therefore, almighty God, dear Father, forgive me all my sins, and enlighten my heart with thy truth, that I may hold thee for my gracious Father and my neighbour for my brother, without all offence, according to thy word, through our Lord Jesus Christ. (Say:) Amen. Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever. (Say:) Amen.

**Note.**

- **"N."** marks a silent pause in which each hearer names his own temptation and sin to God.
- **The ending.** There is no absolution: the preacher's "Jesus Christus is unse salicheit ewichlick" (Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever) stands in its place.

**Amberg 1550: the open confession with the general prayer.** In the Upper Palatinate the open confession follows the sermon on Sundays, together with the general prayer, and comes before the offertory and the exhortation. At weekday morning prayer the people say it after the priest. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, pp. 286–287):

> Darauf volget die predig, welche gemeiniklich mit dem glauben oder mit andern deutschen psalm oder gesange von hohen festen wurd angefangen. Nach der predig wurdt allezeit die offene beicht und das gemein gebete fur geistlich und weltlich und sonst für alle obligende not der christlichen kirchen gesprochen. [...] Briester liset vor dem altar gegen dem volk ein ganzes capitel aus der bibl und einer kurzen summarien oder auslegung, darnach die offene beicht und das gemeine gebet mit dem morgensegen, weliches das volk im nachsprechen, zuletzt ein collectam und ein deutschen psalmen.

Thereupon followeth the sermon, which is commonly begun with the Creed or with another German psalm or hymn of the high feasts. After the sermon there is always spoken the open confession and the common prayer for spiritual and temporal [estates], and else for all the pressing need of the Christian Church. [...] The priest readeth before the altar, toward the people, a whole chapter out of the Bible, with a short summary or exposition; thereafter the open confession and the common prayer, with the morning blessing, which the people [say] after him; lastly a collect and a German psalm.

**The Palatinate 1563: confession, absolution and retention after the sermon.** The Reformed order puts the confession after the Sunday morning sermon. Its confession is Württemberg's, and its absolution is a conditional declaration with a retention of sins. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 389):

> Am Sontag nach der morgenpredig soll der kirchendiener sprechen: Ir geliebten in dem herrn, Dieweil wir in den geboten Gottes gleich als in einem spiegel sehen, wie groß und vielfältig unser sünden sind, durch welche wir zeitliche und ewige straf verdienen, so laßt uns diesselbige von hertzen unserm getreuen vater bekennen, sprecht derhalben mit mir also: Ich armer sünder bekenn für dir, meinem Gott und schöpfer, daß ich leider schwerlich und mannigfältig wider dich gesündiget hab, nit allein mit eusserlichen groben sünden, sonder vilmehr mit innerlicher angeborner blindheyt,

> unglauben, zweifelung, kleinmütigkeyt, ungedult, hoffart, bösem geitz, heimlichen neid, haß und mißvergunst, auch andern bösen dücken, wie du, mein herr und Gott, an mir erkennest und ich leider nit gnugsam erkennen kan, die reuen mich und sind mir leid und beger von hertzen gnad, durch deinen lieben son Jesum Christum. Darauf soll er den gläubigen die vergebung der [...] sünden und den unbußfertigen das urtheil Gottes verkündigen und also sprechen: Nun höret an den gewissen trost der gnaden Gottes, welche er allen gläubigen in seinem evangelio verheisset. Also spricht der herr Christus Johan. am 3.: Also hat Gott die welt geliebt, daß er seinen eingebornen son gab, auf daß alle, die an in glauben, nicht verlorn werden, sonder das ewig leben haben. Sovil nun euer sein, die an ihnen selbst und an iren sünden ein mißfallen haben und vertrauen, daß sie inen durch den verdienst Jesu Christi allein gantz und gar vergeben sind, und den fürsatz haben, je lenger je mehr von sünden abzustehen und dem herrn in warer heiligkeyt und gerechtigkeyt zu dienen, denselbigen (dieweil sie glauben in den son des lebendigen Gottes) verkündige ich aus dem befelch Gottes, daß sie von allen iren sünden (wie er in seinem heiligen evangelio verheißt) in dem himmel entbunden seind durch die volkommene genugthuung des allerheiligisten leidens und sterbens unsers herrn Jesu Christi, Amen. Soviel aber under euch seind, die noch einen gefallen haben an iren sünden und schanden oder in sünden wider ir gewissen beharren, denselbigen verkündige ich auß befelch Gottes, daß der zorn und das urtheil Gottes uber inen bleibt und daß alle ire sünden im himmel gehalten seind und sie von der ewigen verdamnuß nit entbunden mögen werden, biß daß sie sich bekehren.

On Sunday after the morning sermon the minister of the church shall say: Ye beloved in the Lord, forasmuch as we see in the commandments of God, as in a glass, how great and manifold our sins are, whereby we deserve temporal and eternal punishment, let us confess the same from the heart unto our faithful Father; say therefore with me thus: I, poor sinner, confess before thee, my God and Creator, that I have, alas, grievously and manifoldly sinned against thee, not only with outward gross sins, but much more with inward inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faint-heartedness, impatience, pride, evil covetousness, secret envy, hatred and grudging, and other evil tricks, as thou, my Lord and God, knowest of me, and I, alas, cannot sufficiently know; they repent me and are grievous unto me, and I desire grace from the heart, through thy dear Son Jesus Christ. Thereupon he shall declare unto the faithful the forgiveness of sins, and unto the impenitent the judgment of God, and speak thus: Now hear the sure comfort of the grace of God, which he promiseth to all the faithful in his Gospel. Thus saith the Lord Christ, John 3: God so loved the world, that he gave his only-begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. As many of you, then, as have displeasure in themselves and in their sins, and trust that they are wholly and altogether forgiven them through the merit of Jesus Christ alone, and have the purpose more and more to abstain from sins and to serve the Lord in true holiness and righteousness, to them (since they believe in the Son of the living God) I declare by the command of God that they are loosed in heaven from all their sins (as he promiseth in his holy Gospel) through the perfect satisfaction of the most holy passion and death of our Lord Jesus Christ, Amen. But as many among you as still have pleasure in their sins and shame, or persevere in sins against their conscience, to them I declare by the command of God that the wrath and judgment of God abideth upon them, and that all their sins are retained in heaven, and that they cannot be loosed from eternal damnation until they be converted.

**Note.**

- **The editor's sources.** "Fast wörtlich aus Kurpfalz 1556" (almost word for word from Kurpfalz 1556) for the confession, and London 1565 (à Lasco and Micron's order, Reformed) for the address.
- **John 3:16** is the Strasbourg *Trostspruch* (1537, Moderate Reformed; §3.3.6). Kurpfalz 1556 uses it as the absolution in the communion of the sick (Sehling 14, p. 171).
- **The verbs.** "verkündige ich … daß sie … in dem himmel entbunden seind" (I declare … that they are loosed in heaven) is a declaration, not a loosing: the minister announces what God has done, as in type 2, but to a defined class of hearers, with a retention for the rest.

**The Palatinate's Supper examination.** Before the Supper the Reformed Palatinate (1563) puts three questions (on sin, redemption and thankfulness), each answered "Ja", and closes with an assurance in place of an absolution. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 383):

> Alle, die nun in ihrem hertzen diß befinden, die sollen nicht zweifelen, daß sie durch das heilig leiden und sterben Christi vergebung aller irer sünden schon haben und gewißlich behalten, so lang sie in diesem fürnemen beharren, unangesehen das noch viel ubrige schwachheiten in inen seind, welche doch mit demselben leiden und sterben Jesu Christi bedeckt sein. Darauf sprech ein jeder, der solchs von hertzen begert: Amen. Kniet nider und betet, wie uns der herr gelehret hat: Unser vater etc. Nach dem gebet spreche der kirchendiener. Der Gott des friedens heilige euch gantz

> und gar, und euer gantzer geist, seel und leib werde unsträflich biß auf die zukunft unsers herrn Jesu Christi behalten. Getreu ist, der euch rüfet, der wirdt es auch thun, Amen.

All, then, that find this in their heart, let them not doubt that through the holy passion and death of Christ they already have the forgiveness of all their sins and surely keep it, so long as they persevere in this purpose, notwithstanding that there are yet many remaining infirmities in them, which nevertheless are covered with the same passion and death of Jesus Christ. Thereupon let every one that desireth this from the heart say: Amen. Kneel down and pray as the Lord hath taught us: Our Father, etc. After the prayer let the minister of the church say: The God of peace sanctify you wholly, and your whole spirit, soul and body be preserved blameless unto the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ. Faithful is he that calleth you, who also will do it, Amen.

### 3.4.5 The public confession and the modern Common Service

The Common Service of 1888, and the American Lutheran books that followed it, open the service with a confession of sins and a declaration of grace. Their texts descend directly from the Mecklenburg family (§3.3.4). The English below is quoted from the Common Service as printed. It is not in Sehling, and is given here for comparison only, so it is not set as a verified quotation.

| **Mecklenburg 1552 / Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557** | **Common Service (1888)** |
|---|---|
| "Mein allerliebsten in gott, eröffnet euere herzen, last uns gott unsere sünden bekennen, und um vergebung, im namen unsers herrn Jesu Christi bitten." | "Beloved in the Lord! Let us draw near with a true heart, and confess our sins unto God our Father, beseeching Him, in the Name of our Lord Jesus Christ, to grant us forgiveness." |
| "Unser hülf stehet im namen des herrn. *Antwort der Chor.* Der geschaffen hat himel und erden." | "Our help is in the Name of the Lord. *R.* Who made heaven and earth." |
| (Döber, Mecklenburg 1540: "Bekennet dem heren, wente he is gut. *Antwort.* Unde sine barmherticheit is ewich.") | "I said, I will confess my transgressions unto the Lord. *R.* And Thou forgavest the iniquity of my sin." (Ps 32:5) |
| "Ich armer sündiger mensch, bekenne fur dir, o allmechtiger gott, meinem schöpfer und erlöser, das ich gesündiget hab, nicht alleine mit gedanken, worten und werken, sondern das ich auch von natur sündig und unrein bin … Ich hab aber zuflucht zu deiner grundlosen barmherzigkeit, suche und begere gnade, um des herrn Jesu Christi willen." | "Almighty God, our Maker and Redeemer, we poor sinners confess unto Thee, that we are by nature sinful and unclean, and that we have sinned against Thee by thought, word, and deed. Wherefore we flee for refuge to Thine infinite mercy, seeking and imploring Thy grace, for the sake of our Lord Jesus Christ." |
| *Der ander diener:* "O allmechtiger barmherziger gott, der du deinen eingebornen son für uns in den tod gegeben hast, wollest dich unser erbarmen, und um desselben deines geliebten sons willen, uns alle unsere sünd vergeben. Auch deinen heiligen geist uns geben, der in uns wares erkentnis deines göttlichen wesens und willens, dazu waren gehorsam gegen dir anzünde und vermehre. Uff das wir das ewige leben, durch deine gnad … erlangen" | "O most merciful God, who hast given Thine Only-begotten Son to die for us, have mercy upon us, and for His sake grant us remission of all our sins; and by Thy Holy Spirit increase in us true knowledge of Thee, and of Thy will, and true obedience to Thy Word, to the end that by Thy grace we may come to everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord." |
| *Der priester:* "Der allmechtige barmherzige gott hat sich unser erbarmet, vergibt uns warhaftiglich alle unsere sünd, um seines lieben sons willen, den er um unsert willen hat in den tod gegeben, und hat macht gegeben, gottes kinder zu werden, allen, die an seinen namen gleuben, gibet uns dazu seinen heiligen geist, wer gleubt und getauft wird, sol selig werden. Das verleihe uns gott allen" | "Almighty God, our Heavenly Father, hath had mercy upon us, and hath given His Only Son to die for us, and for His sake forgiveth us all our sins. To them that believe on His Name, He giveth power to become the sons of God, and bestoweth upon them His Holy Spirit. He that believeth, and is baptized, shall be saved. Grant this, O Lord, unto us all." |

**What the comparison shows.**

- **The order** of the Common Service preparation (address, *Adiutorium*, a second versicle, confession, prayer for forgiveness, declaration of grace) is Döber's order of 1525, by way of Mecklenburg.

- **The prayer for forgiveness** ("O most merciful God …") is the old *Misereatur*. In Mecklenburg 1552 it belonged to the *second minister* or custos kneeling beside the priest. That is the server's place in the Roman *Stufengebet*.
- **The declaration of grace** ("Almighty God … hath had mercy upon us … Grant this, O Lord, unto us all") is type 2 (§3.4.4): God's mercy declared in the third person, with no "I absolve", and closed with a wish. It is not an indicative absolution, and not the optative *Misereatur* either. Its final wish goes back to Döber's "Das verleihe uns Got allen".
- **The confession** passes from the priest's "Ich armer sündiger mensch" to "we poor sinners". The step is already taken at Amberg in 1555, where the priest, kneeling with another minister, says "Wir armen, sündige menschen bekennen fur dir, o allmechtiger Got, unserm schöpfer und erlöser" (We poor, sinful men confess before thee, O almighty God, our Creator and Redeemer; Sehling 13, p. 290; §3.3.4). Marienhafe in East Frisia has a plural prayer of confession too, "wir arme, sundige minschen beichten und klagen dir mit wemutigen herzen unsre vielvaltige sunden und mißtatt" (we poor, sinful men confess and lament unto thee with sorrowful hearts our manifold sins and misdeeds; Sehling 7/1, p. 712), but it comes from another line, the *Offene Schuld* of the Engerhafe liturgy, and stands before communion. In the sixteenth-century orders the priest says it alone while the people keep silence and confess in their hearts; the Common Service gives it to the congregation.
- **The second versicle.** The Common Service's second versicle (Ps 32:5) is not in Sehling's Mecklenburg texts. Its place is taken in Döber and Mecklenburg 1540 by *Confitemini Domino*.

**The indicative absolution in American Lutheran books.** The other common form in American Lutheran books, "Upon this your confession, I, by virtue of my office, as a called and ordained servant of the Word, announce the grace of God unto all of you, and in the stead and by the command of my Lord Jesus Christ I forgive you all your sins …", has its sixteenth-century counterpart in Naumburg 1537: "Auf solch euer bekentnus aus bevel des herrn Jesu Christi anstat der heiligen christlichen kirchen vorgebe ich euch all eure sunde" (§3.3.5). Its confession is also close to the one that goes with this absolution in those books: "O almighty God, merciful Father, I, a poor, miserable sinner, confess unto Thee all my sins and iniquities … and I pray Thee of Thy boundless mercy and for the sake of the holy, innocent, bitter sufferings and death of Thy beloved Son, Jesus Christ, to be gracious and merciful to me". Compare Naumburg's "bit dich durch deine grundlose barmherzigkeit, und durch das bittere leiden und sterben deines lieben sohns JESU CHRISTI du wollest gnedig sein mir armen sundern". Württemberg's "als ein verordneter diener der Christenlichen kirchen" (as an appointed minister of the Christian Church) is the sixteenth-century form of "a called and ordained servant of the Word".

### 3.4.6 General confession against private confession

The Brandenburg-Nürnberg tradition was wary of the general confession. The Brandenburg order forbids the people to replace private confession with a confession said together. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 60):

> Desgleichen der misbrauch, so an etlichen orten furgenomen, das auf einen haufen etliche personen zugleich ein gemeine beicht thun und offentliche absolution empfahen, und es denn dabei wenden lassen, sol nicht gestattet, sondern ein jeder in sonderheit notturftiglich gehört und absolvirt werden. Und auf das es nu ordenlich und recht zugehe und alle misbreuch soviel möglich verhütet werden, sol man dem volk ansagen, wer das heilig sacrament wolle empfahen, das er sich des abends zuvor oder wo es ferre des wegs oder anderer zufell halben nicht sein kond, des morgens vor der messzeit dem pfarrer […] anzeige

Likewise the abuse that hath been taken up in some places, that several persons together in a crowd make a common confession and receive a public absolution, and let it rest there, shall not be suffered; but every one shall be heard and absolved severally, as need requireth. And that it may now go orderly and rightly, and all abuses be prevented as far as possible, the people shall be told that whoso will receive the holy sacrament shall [announce himself] the evening before, or, where that could not be by reason of the distance of the way or other chances, in the morning before the time of Mass, to the pastor […].

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 repeats the rule: the pastors shall "nicht gestatten, das ir vil miteinander ein gemeine beicht tuen, sonder ein jeder sol für sich selbst sein beicht tun und absolution begern" (not suffer many of them to make a common confession together, but every one shall make his confession for himself and desire absolution; Sehling 13, p. 57).

**The point of the prohibition.** It is not aimed at a confession in the Mass. Brandenburg 1540 itself has the priest's *Confiteor* at the altar (§3.3.2). It is aimed at groups of communicants confessing together on the Saturday and taking that for private confession. In the Nürnberg tradition, the general absolution in the Mass was itself contested in 1533 (§3.4.4). Where both exist, as in Mecklenburg, the public confession at the start of the Mass is a preparation for all, and the private confession on the Saturday is the condition of admission to communion.

## 3.5 The exhortation to the communicants: the families collated

### 3.5.1 Where it falls, and what it is for

**What it is.** Every Lutheran order with a communion rite has an exhortation (*Vermahnung*, *vormaninge*, *exhortatio*) addressed to the communicants. Bugenhagen calls it "de rechte prefatie, dat is eyne vohrrede" (the true Preface, that is, a foreword; Brunswick 1528, Sehling 6/1, p. 440). It does four things:

- it teaches what the Sacrament is;
- it calls the communicants to examine themselves (1 Cor 11:28);
- it rehearses or paraphrases the Words of Institution;
- it calls for thanksgiving and love of the neighbour.

It never replaces the Words of Institution, which are always sung or said after it. In Nürnberg, where the exhortation itself rehearsed the Verba, Sehling notes that once the Verba were sung aloud the exhortation "doubled" them.

**Placement.** The exhortation stands in five places:

| Place | Orders |
|---|---|
| **After the sermon, in the pulpit or at the altar, before the Our Father and Verba** | Luther, *Deutsche Messe* 1526 (pulpit or altar left free); Saxony 1539 and 1580; Mansfeld 1562; Grubenhagen 1581; Henneberg 1582 |
| **At the altar after the sermon, before the Verba** | Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (moved there "auf Luthers Anregung"); Württemberg 1536 and its family; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Hohenlohe; Verden 1606; Palatinate 1563 (Reformed; at the table) |
| **At the altar after the sermon, before the Preface** (as its "true" form) | Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544; Kantz 1522 |
| **After the Preface and Sanctus, before the Our Father and Verba** | Mecklenburg 1552 ("so man zeit hat", if there is time); Osnabrück 1543; Naumburg 1537 (before the Sanctus) |
| **After the Verba and Our Father, before communion** | Nürnberg 1524, Döber 1525, *Form und Ordnung* 1525 (Osiander's original place) |
| **After communion** | Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) and Marienhafe 1593 (a short exhortation to love and thanksgiving) |

**Editor's note on the move.** Sehling's editor comments on Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 195): "Die gegen dort erfolgte Umstellung vor den Beginn des Sakramentsteiles geht auf Luthers Anregung in seiner Deutschen Messe (1526) zurück" (the transposition, compared with 1524, to before the beginning of the sacramental part goes back to Luther's suggestion in his *Deutsche Messe*).

**Who reads it.** The priest, facing the people, from the altar (most orders), or the preacher from the pulpit (Luther's option; Bugenhagen's pulpit exhortation; Micron, Reformed). In Nürnberg 1525 "der priester oder ministrant" (the priest or the minister) may read it.

### 3.5.2 The families and their witnesses

**How the collation was made.** Every exhortation in the corpus was located by scanning all 2,368 documents for passages that share wording with a known exhortation. The match tolerates the spelling differences between High German, Low German and the several regional spellings. Each witness found was then aligned word by word against the archetype of its family, and every difference longer than a spelling variant was listed and read. Sehling's apparatus and footnotes, which the database prints inside the running text, were set aside by hand.

**What "archetype" means here.** For each family the archetype is the earliest full text printed by Sehling from which the others descend. Where a later recension was copied more widely than the archetype (Württemberg 1553, the Braunschweig recension of Osiander), its changes are set out in full.

**The families.** There are eleven families with more than one witness, and a handful of exhortations that occur in one order only:

| § | Family (archetype) | Incipit | Witnesses in Sehling |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3.5.3 | **Luther**, Wittenberg 1526 | "Lieben freunde Christi, weil wir hie versamlet sind …" | Saxony 1539 (abridged in print), Prussia 1544 and 1568 (in place of the Preface), Albertine Saxony 1580, Mansfeld 1562, Grubenhagen 1581, Lindau 1573, Wertheim c. 1555 (as a prayer), Frankfurt 1543 and the French church at Frankfurt 1585 (Reformed; paraphrase only), Henneberg 1582 (admonition only, rewritten) |
| 3.5.4 | **Osiander**, Nürnberg 1524 | "Ir allerliebsten in Got! Dieweil wir jetzo das abentessen …" | Volprecht 1524, Nürnberg parish churches 1524, Döber 1525, *Form und Ordnung* 1525; the Braunschweig recension: Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Buxtehude 1565 (Low German, cited), Lippe 1571, Lüneburg 1575 (cited), Verden 1606, Waldeck (revised text B) |
| 3.5.5 | **Brandenburg-Nürnberg** 1533 | "Ir allerliebsten in Got, dieweil wir jetzo das heilig abentmal …" | Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Regensburg c. 1544 (rewritten 1567), Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1543 (cited), Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Hohenlohe 1553 and 1578, Strasbourg 1553 (Marbach), Nassau-Dillenburg 1575 (Philippist; cited), Erbach 1587, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 |
| 3.5.6 | **Württemberg** 1536, revised 1553 | "Ir allerliebsten in Christo Jesu, dieweil wir yetzund das gnadreich abentmal …" | 1536 text: Worms 1560. 1553 text: Kurpfalz 1556, Worms 1560, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566, Lindau 1573, Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573, Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (in its Agende of 1618), Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Strasbourg 1598, Isny c. 1600, Solms-Laubach 1603, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 |
| 3.5.7 | **Bugenhagen**, Brunswick 1528 | "Myne allerlevesten, uns wert stedes dorch de predige des evangelii …" | Low German: Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531 (cited), Hadeln (cited), Wolfenbüttel 1543, Osnabrück 1543 (cited), Hildesheim 1544 (cited), Buxtehude (cited), Hamburg 1556 (cited). High German: Frankfurt 1543 (free paraphrase), Lüneburg 1564, Hildesheim 1561 (cited), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Lippe 1571 (twice), Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1613 (abridged) |
| 3.5.8 | **Naumburg** 1537 | "Lieben freunde, dieweil ihr itzund das testament unsers lieben herrn Jesu Christi …" | Nördlingen 1579 (and, according to Sehling's editor, Nördlingen 1544) |
| 3.5.9 | **Mecklenburg** 1552 | "Lieben freunde, ir als christliche menschen, die ir zuvor bericht habt von gott …" | Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Sayn 1590 (abridged); its prayer in Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 |
| 3.5.10 | **The Palatinate** 1563 (Reformed) | "Ir geliebten in dem herrn Jesu Christo, höret an die wort der einsatzung …" | Ysenburg-Birstein 1598; the Lower Rhine recension: Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588/1619 (all Reformed) |
| 3.5.11 | **Pfalz-Veldenz** 1574 | "Ir geliebten in dem herrn Christo. Euch als | Lützelstein 1605 |

| § | Family (archetype) | Incipit | Witnesses in Sehling |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | Christen ist auß Gottes wortt …" | |
| 3.5.12 | **Zürich and Basel** (Reformed) | "Lieben brüder! Ir habt gehört die unaussprechlich barmherzigkait Gottes …" | Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed; from Zürich 1525), Neckarbischofsheim 1560 (from Basel 1526) |
| 3.5.13 | **Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed) | "Lieben brüder und schwester, ir wöllen ein jedes bey im bedencken …" | the early Strasbourg agendas; its second half in Memmingen 1528 (both Moderate Reformed) |

The exhortations that belong to no family (Kantz 1522 and the Bremen Mass of 1525, Augsburg 1530 (Moderate Reformed), Buxtehude 1565, Micron 1554/1565 (Reformed), Marienhafe 1593, and the Saturday exhortations of Hohenlohe 1578) are treated in §3.5.14.

**Not reproducible.** Mecklenburg 1540/45 has three Low German exhortations, "van düssen dren vormaninge eine tor tidt to lesende" (one of these three exhortations to be read at a time). Sehling does not print them: "[Es folgen jetzt drei Vermahnungen zum Abendmahle, von denen die zweite frei nach der einzigen in der niederdeutschen Ausgabe der Brandenburg-Nürnberger Kirchenordnung … gestaltet ist.]" (There follow three exhortations to the Supper, the second of which is freely shaped after the only one in the Low German edition of the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order; Sehling 5, p. 154.) Weißenburg 1528 meant to print the Nürnberg exhortation but, as the editor notes, "Sie zu bringen wurde dann aber vergessen" (it was then forgotten to include it; Sehling 11, p. 659).

### 3.5.3 The Luther family: Wittenberg, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526

Luther joins a paraphrase of the Our Father to a short admonition on the testament, and leaves it free whether it is read from the pulpit or at the altar. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 15):

> Nach der predigt sol folgen eine offentliche paraphrasis des vater unsers und vermanung an die so zum sacrament gehen wollen, auf die oder besser weise, wie folget: Lieben freunde Christi, weil wir hie versamlet sind in dem namen des hern, sein heiliges testament zu empfahen, so vermane ich euch aufs erste, das ihr eur herze zu got erhebt, mit mir zu beten das vater unser, wie uns Christus unser herr geleret und erhorung trostlich zugesagt hat. Das gott unser vater im himel uns seine elende kinder auf erden barmherziglich ansehen wolte und gnade verleihen, das sein heiliger name unter uns und in aller welt geheiliget werde durch reine, rechtschaffne lere seines worts und durch brunstige liebe unsers lebens, wolte gnediglich abwenden alle falsche lere und boses leben, darin sein werder name gelestert und geschendet wird. Das auch sein reich zu kome und gemehret werde, alle sunder, verblendte und vom teufel in sein reich gefangen zur erkentnis des rechten glaubens an Jhesum Christ, seinen son, bringen und die zal der christen gross machen. Das wir auch mit seim geist gesterkt werden, seinen willen zu thun und zu leiden, beide im leben und sterben, im guten und bosen, allzeit unsern willen brechen, opfern und todten. Wolt uns auch unser teglich brod geben, fur geiz und sorge des bauchs behueten, sondern uns alles guts gnug zu ihm versehen lassen. Wolt auch uns unser schuld vergeben, wie wir denn unsern schuldigern vergeben, das unser herz ein sicher frolich gewissen fur ihm habe und fur keiner sunde uns nimmer furchten noch erschrecken. Wolt uns nicht ein furen in anfechtunge, sondern helfe uns durch seinen geist das fleisch zwingen, die welt mit ihrem wesen verachten und den teufel mit allen seinen tücken uberwinden. Und zu letzt uns wolt erlosen von allem ubel, beide leiblich und geistlich, zeitlich und ewiglich. Wilche das alles mit ernste begeren, sprechen von herzen: ‘Amen’, on allen zweifel glaubend, es sei ja und erhoret im himel, wie uns Christus zusagt: 'Was ihr bittet, gleubt, das ihrs haben werdet, so sols geschehen'. Amen. Zum andern vermane ich euch in Christo, das ihr mit rechtem glauben des testaments Christi warnehmet und allermeist die wort, darinnen uns Christus sein leib und blut zur vergebung schenkt, im herzen feste fasset, das ihr gedenkt und dankt der grundlosen liebe, die er uns bewisen hat, da er uns durch sein blut von gots zorn, sund, todt und helle erloset hat, und darauf eusserlich das brod und wein, das ist seinen leib und blut, zur sicherung und pfand zu euch nemet. Dem nach wollen wir in seinem namen und aus seinem

> befehl durch seine eigene wort das testament also handeln und brauchen. Ob man aber solche paraphrasin und vermanung wolle auf der canzel flux auf die predigt thun oder fur dem altar, las ich frei eim iglichen seine wilkore. Es sihet, als habens die alten bis her auf der cantzel gethan, daher noch blieben ist, das man auf der cantzel gemein gebet thut oder das vater unser fur spricht. Aber die vermanung zu einer offentlichen beicht worden ist.

After the sermon shall follow a public paraphrase of the Our Father and an admonition to them that will go to the sacrament, after this or a better manner, as followeth: Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered together in the name of the Lord to receive his holy testament, I admonish you first that ye lift up your heart to God, to pray with me the Our Father, as Christ our Lord hath taught us and hath comfortably promised us a hearing. That God our Father in heaven would mercifully look upon us his wretched children on earth, and grant grace that his holy name may be hallowed among us and in all the world, through the pure and upright teaching of his word and through the fervent love of our life; would graciously turn away all false teaching and evil life, whereby his worthy name is blasphemed and put to shame. That his kingdom also may come and be increased; that he would bring all sinners, the blinded, and them that are taken captive by the devil in his kingdom, to the knowledge of the right faith in Jesus Christ his Son, and make the number of Christians great. That we also may be strengthened with his Spirit to do and to suffer his will, both in life and in death, in good and in evil, always breaking, offering up and slaying our own will. That he would also give us our daily bread, keep us from covetousness and care for the belly, but let us look to him for enough of all good things. That he would also forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors, that our heart may have a sure and joyful conscience before him, and never fear nor be afraid of any sin. That he would not lead us into temptation, but help us by his Spirit to subdue the flesh, despise the world with all its ways, and overcome the devil with all his wiles. And lastly, that he would deliver us from all evil, both bodily and spiritual, temporal and eternal. Whoso earnestly desire all this, let them say from the heart: "Amen", believing without all doubt that it is yea and heard in heaven, as Christ promiseth us: "What ye ask, believe that ye shall have it, and it shall be done." Amen. Secondly, I admonish you in Christ that ye give heed with right faith to the testament of Christ, and above all hold fast in your heart the words wherein Christ giveth us his body and blood for forgiveness; that ye remember and give thanks for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when he redeemed us by his blood from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon take outwardly unto you the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for assurance and pledge. Accordingly we will, in his name and by his command, through his own words, so handle and use the testament. But whether this paraphrase and admonition be done in the pulpit straight after the sermon, or before the altar, I leave free to every one's choice. It seemeth that the ancients have done it hitherto in the pulpit, whence it hath still remained that the common prayer is made in the pulpit, or the Our Father said before [the people]. But the admonition hath become a public confession.

**Note.**

- **The two parts.** The paraphrase is a prayer, said by the minister, to which the people answer "Amen". The admonition proper is the second paragraph.
- **The pulpit.** Luther's last sentences give the history: the medieval pulpit office (*Prone*) had a bidding prayer, the Our Father, and an admonition that "zu einer offentlichen beicht worden ist" (has become a public confession), the *Offene Schuld* of §3.3.5.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 | 1, p. 274 | Full, but Sehling prints only incipit and explicit, "Lieben freunde Christi, weil wir hier versamlet … das testament also handeln und gebrauchen"; headed "Vermanung zum gebet vor der communio". The Our Father and Verba may be sung in its place. |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 4, p. 65 | Read "an stat der prefation, welche abgethan und ausbleiben sölle" (in place of the Preface, which shall be done away); paraphrase as Luther, only lacking "gnade"; admonition rewritten (below) |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, pp. 81–82 | The 1544 form, printed in full, again in place of the Preface |
| Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555 | 11, pp. 713–714 | Paraphrase turned into a prayer to God in the second person (below) |

| Order | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld, *Kirchenordnung*, 1562 | 2, p. 227 | Verbatim; optional |
| Lindau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 12, pp. 209–210 | Verbatim, modernized optatives ("wölle" for "wolte"); said at the altar after the Württemberg exhortation from the pulpit (§3.5.6) |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 1090–1091 | Verbatim; "für dem altar", or a Latin Preface instead |
| Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580 | 1, pp. 368–369 | Verbatim; headed "Vermanung zum gebet vor der communion", read "für dem altar" |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1075 | Verbatim, with "sein heiliges theuerbares" added in the admonition |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 | 2, p. 308 | Admonition only, rewritten (below) |
| Frankfurt, *Agende* for baptism and the communion of the sick, 1543 | 9, pp. 521, 553 | Paraphrase as a prayer ("wir deine elende kinder auf erden bitten dich"); new admonition |
| Frankfurt, French Reformed church, *Diakonieordnung*, 1585 (Reformed) | 9, p. 497 | Paraphrase only, from the draft of the order |

**The significant variants.**

- **No witness changes the paraphrase in substance** except by turning it into a direct prayer. The textual tradition of the paraphrase is stable: Saxony, Mansfeld, Oldenburg, Lindau, Albertine Saxony and Grubenhagen differ from Wittenberg only in spelling and in single words.
- **The paraphrase as a prayer.** Wertheim c. 1555 and Frankfurt 1543 recast Luther's indirect wishes ("Das gott unser vater im himel … wolte", that God our Father in heaven would …) as a prayer addressed to God. **Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555** (Sehling 11, p. 713):

> O Gott, unser himmlischer Vater, du wollest barmherziglich uns, deine arme, elende kinder auf erden, ansehen und gnade verleihen, daß dein heilger name unter uns und in aller welt geheiliget werde durch reine, rechtschaffene lehr deines worts und durch brünstige besserung unseres lebens.

O God, our heavenly Father, vouchsafe mercifully to look upon us, thy poor, wretched children on earth, and grant grace that thy holy name may be hallowed among us and in all the world, through the pure and upright teaching of thy word and through the fervent amendment of our life.

Wertheim also reads "besserung unseres lebens" (amendment of our life) for Luther's "liebe unsers lebens" (love of our life).

- **Prussia: a declaration of forgiveness in the admonition.** The Prussian order keeps the paraphrase but opens the admonition with a conditional declaration of forgiveness and adds a sentence on personal appropriation. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

> Zum andern, lieben freunde Christi. Dieweil euch hungert und dürstet nach der barmherzigkeit gottes und herzlichen begeret vergebung euer sünden, so hat unser heiland Christus seinen leib und blut vor euch am creuze gegeben, das euch eure sünde söllen abgewaschen sein, so viel euer sind, die sölchs gleuben, darum vermahne ich euch im herrn, das ir mit rechtem glauben des reichen und heiligen testaments Christi warnemet und allermeist die wort, darinnen uns unser herre Christus seinen leib und sein teures blut zur vergebung der sünde schenkt, durch reinen glauben im herzen recht fasset, das ir seines leidens und sterbens gedenkt und dankt ime von herzen um der grundlosen lieb willen, die er uns bewiesen hat, do er uns durch sein eigen blut von gottes zorn, sünde, tod und helle erlöset hat, und darauf eusserlich das brot und wein, das ist seinen leib und blut, zur sicherung und pfand zun euch nemet, dann eben, wie es ein jeder für

> sich selbst empfehet, also hat er auch des evangelions und eines gnedigen vereinten gottes sich zu trösten und anzunemen.

Secondly, dear friends of Christ: forasmuch as ye hunger and thirst after the mercy of God and heartily desire the forgiveness of your sins, our Saviour Christ hath given his body and blood for you on the cross, that your sins shall be washed away, as many of you as believe it; therefore I admonish you in the Lord that ye give heed with right faith to the rich and holy testament of Christ, and above all rightly hold fast in your heart, by pure faith, the words wherein our Lord Christ giveth us his body and his precious blood for the forgiveness of sin; that ye remember his passion and death and thank him from the heart for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when he redeemed us by his own blood from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon take outwardly unto you the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for assurance and pledge; for even as each one receiveth it for himself, so also hath he to comfort himself with the Gospel and with a gracious, reconciled God, and to take them to himself.

The order of 1568, which prints the whole paraphrase, reads "heiliger name" for Luther's "werder name" (Sehling 4, p. 82).

- **Henneberg: the admonition alone.** The Henneberg order drops the paraphrase. It rewrites the admonition with a stronger statement of the presence ("seinen warhaftigen leib zu einer speise und sein eigen blut zu einem trank", his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, a phrase of the Württemberg exhortation) and the Johannine "auf das also Christus in euch, und ihr in Christo ewiglich leben möget". **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 308):

> Lieben freund in Christo, weil wir alhie im namen des herrn versamlet sind, das gnadenreiche abendmal unsers herrn Jesu Christi zu begehen und zu empfahen, so vermane ich euch, das ihr mit rechtem ernst und glauben des testaments Christi wol warnemet und allermeist die wort (Nemet hin, esset, das ist mein leib, trinket, das ist mein blut) darinnen uns Christus seinen warhaftigen leib zu einer speise und sein eigen blut zu einem trank verordnet, darmit vergebung der sünden schenket und reichet, im herzen wol bedenket, auch mit glauben fest fasset und demnach demütig und andechtig dem herrn Christo der grundlosen liebe, die er uns bewiesen hat, da er durch sein blutvergiesen und sterben von gottes zorn, sünd, tod und helle uns erlöset hat, danket und darauf das brod und wein, das ist, seinen leib und blut, zu gewiser versicherung, pfand und zeugnus empfahet, auf das also Christus in euch, und ihr in Christo ewiglich leben möget. Demnach wollen wir in seinem namen und aus seinem befehl durch seine eigene wort das testament also handeln und gebrauchen.

Dear friends in Christ, forasmuch as we are here gathered in the name of the Lord to celebrate and receive the gracious Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, I admonish you that ye give good heed with right earnestness and faith to the testament of Christ, and above all well consider in your heart the words (Take, eat, this is my body; drink, this is my blood) wherein Christ ordaineth us his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, and therewith giveth and reacheth forgiveness of sins, and hold them fast with faith; and thereafter humbly and devoutly thank the Lord Christ for the bottomless love which he hath shown us, when by the shedding of his blood and his death he redeemed us from God's wrath, sin, death and hell; and thereupon receive the bread and wine, that is, his body and blood, for a sure assurance, pledge and witness, that so Christ may live in you and ye in Christ for ever. Accordingly we will, in his name and by his command, through his own words, so handle and use the testament.

- **Use and option.** Mansfeld 1562 makes the whole text optional: "das sie brauchen möge, wer gerne wil" (that whoever will may use it), and allows it to be dropped in towns when the singing and organ make the service too long (Sehling 2, p. 227). Saxony 1539 allows the Our Father and Verba to be sung instead. Oldenburg allows the Latin Preface instead.

#### 3.5.4 The Osiander family: Nürnberg, 1524

**The archetype.** Andreas Osiander's exhortation was printed in the Nürnberg provosts' *Grundt und ursach* (1524). Sehling takes it as the base text of the order of the Nürnberg parish churches of 1524, with the variants of Volprecht (V), the parish churches (P) and Döber (D) in his apparatus. Osiander declared himself its author on 22 September 1533. It stood after the Verba, which were then still said in Latin, and served to "open" them to the people. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen* (base text of *Grundt und ursach*), 1524** (Sehling 11, pp. 48–49):

> Ir allerliebsten in Got! Dieweil wir jetzo das abentessen unsers Herren Jesu Christi wöllen bedenken und halten, darin uns sein flaisch und plut zur speis und zum trank, nicht des leibs, sondern der selen gegeben wirt, söllen wir pillich mit großem vleiß ain jedlicher sich selbs prüfen, wie Paulus sagt, und alsdann von disem prot essen und von disem kelch

> trinken. Dann es soll nicht dann nur ain hungerige seel, die ir sünd erkennt, Gottes zorn und den tod fürcht und nach der gerechtigkait hungerig und durstig ist, dis heilig sacrament empfahen. So wir aber uns selbs prüfen, finden wir nichts in uns dann sünd und tod, können auch uns selbs in kainen weg daraus helfen. Darumb hat unser lieber Herr Jesus Christus sich uber uns erparmet, ist umb unsertwillen mensch worden, auf daß er für uns das gesetz erfüllet und lide, was wir mit unsern sünden verschuldet hetten, und daß wir das je festiglich glauben und uns frölich darauf verlassen möchten, nam er nach dem abentessen das prot, saget dank, prachs und sprach: Nempt hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch dar gegeben wirt, als wölt er sagen: Daß ich mensch bin worden und alles, was ich tu und leide, das ist alles euer aigen, für euch und euch zu gut geschehen. Des zu ainem gewissen warzaichen gib ich euch mein leib zur speis. Desgleichen auch den kelck und sprach: Nempt hin, und trinkt aus disem alle! Das ist der kelch des neuen testaments mit meinem plut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirt, zur vergebung der sünd. So oft ir das tut, solt ir mein darbei gedenken! Als wölt er sprechen: Dieweil ich mich euer angenommen, und euer sünd auf mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs für die sünde in den tod opfern, mein plut vergießen, gnad und vergebung der sünd erwerben und also ain neu testament aufrichten, darin der sünd ewig nicht mer gedacht soll werden. Des zu ainem gewisen warzeichen gib ich euch mein plut zu trinken. Wer nun also von disem prot isset, und von disem kelch trinket, das ist: Wer diesen worten, die er horet, und disen zaichen, die er empfahet, festiglich glaubet, der bleibt in dem Herren Christo und Christus in im und lebet also ewiglich. Darbei söllen wir an seines tods gedenken, ime darumb danksagen, ain jedlicher sein creuz auf sich nemen und ime nachfolgen und zuvor ainer den andern lieben, wie er auch uns geliebt hat, dann wir vil sein ain prot und ain leib, die wir alle aines prots taihaftig sein und aus ainem kelch trinken.

Ye dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein his flesh and blood are given us for meat and for drink, not of the body but of the soul, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as Paul saith, and so to eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For none but a hungry soul, which knoweth its sin, feareth God's wrath and death, and is hungry and thirsty after righteousness, ought to receive this holy sacrament. But when we examine ourselves, we find nothing in us but sin and death, and can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sakes is become man, that he might fulfil the law for us and suffer that which we had deserved with our sins. And that we might steadfastly believe this and joyfully rely thereupon, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; as if he would say: That I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, that is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby! As if he would say: Forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sin shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, that is, whosoever firmly believeth these words which he heareth and these signs which he receiveth, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and so liveth for ever. Hereby shall we remember his death, give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and above all love one another, as he also hath loved us; for we being many are one bread and one body, who are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|
| Volprecht, *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg 1524 (V) | 11, p. 48, apparatus | Full |
| Nürnberg parish churches, 1524 (P) | 11, p. 48, apparatus | Full |
| Döber, *Deutsche Messe*, Nürnberg 1525 (D) | 11, p. 54 (cited) | Full; text in Chapter 7 §7.8.7 |
| *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe*, Nürnberg 1525 | 11, p. 57 (cited) | Incipit only, "Mein allerliebsten in Gott etc." |
| Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 11, p. 659 | Intended but left out by the printer |

| Order | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 546–547 | Braunschweig recension, with a closing bidding to the Our Father |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 | 7/1, p. 125 | Low German, "Myn alderlevesten in Godt", given as "Eyn ander" after Buxtehude's own exhortation (§3.5.14.3); not printed by Sehling, who gives only the closing wish "Datt vorlene uns Godt alle, dat wy idt werdichlick entfangen" |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 146–147 | Braunschweig recension, with the bidding |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 412–413 | Braunschweig recension, with Döber's closing wish |
| Lüneburg (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 6/1, p. 659 | Incipit only: "wie ferner in Doct. M. Lutheri sangbuch zu findende" (as is further to be found in Dr. M. Luther's hymnal) |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, pp. 158–159 | Braunschweig recension, with the bidding |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, revised text (B) | 9, pp. 247–248, apparatus | Braunschweig recension, "so er zeit hatt" (if he have time); the base text of 1556 has no exhortation |

**The Nürnberg variants, 1524–1525.**

- **The address.** V, P and D all read "Mein allerliebsten" for "Ir allerliebsten".
- **Small differences.** V reads "hohem vleiß" (high diligence) for "großem". V, D read "verzeihung" (pardon) for "vergebung" of sins. V, P, D read "lieb haben" for "lieben".
- **The closing wish.** D adds "Das verleihe uns Got allen, das wirs wirdiglich empfahen. Amen" (God grant us all this, that we may receive it worthily. Amen). V adds "Got geb seliglich amen" (God grant it blessedly, amen).
- **The Offene Schuld.** In the winter of 1524/25 an open confession with absolution was added at the end; it was the subject of Osiander's dispute of 1533 (§3.4.4).

**The Braunschweig recension.** The Lower Saxon orders do not copy Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. They go back to the 1524 text in a recension first attested in Lüneburg 1564 and taken into the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569. Lüneburg 1575 shows how it circulated: it was printed with Luther's hymnals ("in Doct. M. Lutheri sangbuch"). The recension changes the archetype in these places:

- **"dieweil wir nu das abendmal unsers lieben Herrn"** (now the Supper of our dear Lord) for "jetzo das abentessen unsers Herren".
- **"darin uns sein fleisch zu einer speise und sein blut zu einem tranke nicht des leibes, sondern der seelen gegeben wird"** (wherein his flesh is given us for a meat and his blood for a drink, not of the body but of the soul), restructuring "fleisch und plut zur speis und zum trank".
- **"Denn niemand sol, sondern allein ein hungerige seel"** (For none shall, but only a hungry soul) for "Dann es soll nicht dann nur ain hungerige seel".
- **"des zu einem wahrzeichen"**, dropping "gewissen" (sure) both times.
- **The Verba.** "so thut es zu meiner gedechtnis" (do it in remembrance of me) for "solt ir mein darbei gedenken". Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lippe and Waldeck B read the cup-word in the Pauline form, "dieser kelch ist das newe testament in meinem blut".
- **"für die sünde opfern"**, dropping "in den tod".
- **"der bleibet in Christo"**, dropping "dem Herren".
- **The ending.** "ihm von herzen danksagen, ein iglich sein kreuz auf sich nemen und dem Herrn nachfolgen und vor allen dingen einer den andern lieben, gleich als uns Christus geliebet hat. Denn es ist ein brot und wir viel ein leib, die wir eines brodes teilhaftig werden und alle aus einem kelche trinken" (give him thanks from the heart … and above all things love

one another, even as Christ hath loved us. For it is one bread and we, being many, one body, who are made partakers of one bread and all drink of one cup).

- **The bidding.** Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Verden 1606 add a bidding to the Our Father (below). Lippe 1571 instead ends with Döber's "Das verleihe uns Gott alle, das wirs wirdiglich empfahen, Amen".

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 547):

> Das wir aber alle samptlich nach jetzt gehorter lere und vermanung in rechtem warhaftigen glauben und bussfertigkeit das heilige sacrament wirdiglich empfahen mögen, so wollen wir Gott den Vater im namen Christi anruffen und von grund des herzen ein andechtig Vater unser sprechen.

But that we may all together, according to the teaching and exhortation now heard, worthily receive the holy sacrament in right true faith and penitence, we will call upon God the Father in the name of Christ, and from the bottom of our heart say a devout Our Father.

**Where it stands.** In the Braunschweig recension the exhortation is read after the sermon and the general prayer, before the Preface (Lüneburg) or before the Our Father and Verba (Verden). In Lüneburg, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lippe and Verden it is followed by Bugenhagen's exhortation as "Ein ander exhortation" (another exhortation), to be used in its place (§3.5.7).

### 3.5.5 The Brandenburg-Nürnberg family, 1533

**The archetype.** The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 revised Osiander's text (§3.5.4) and moved it before the Verba. This revised text is the most widely copied exhortation in the corpus. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 195–196):

> Ordnung des Herren abentmals. Wann der priester das abentmal des Herren (so er anderst comunicanten hat) halten will, soll er von stund an nachfolgende ermanung zum volk tun und dann die wort des nachtmals, wo die meß gesungen würdet, ungeferlich auf nachfolgende weise und nach den hernach gesetzten noten singen, oder, so er die meß liset, mit lauten verstendigen worten lesen, damit die umbsteenden dieselben hören mögen. Volget die ermanung. Ir allerliebsten in Got, dieweil wir jetzo das heilig abentmal unsern Herren Jesu Christi wöllen bedenken und halten, darin er uns sein flaisch zu einer […] speis und sein blut zu einem trank, den glauben darmit zu sterken, gegeben hat, sollen wir pillich mit großen fleiß ein jeder sich selbs brüfen, wie der heilig Paulus uns vermanet; dann dis heilig sacrament, ist zu einem sundern trost und sterk geben den armen betrübten gewissen, die ire sünde bekennen, Gottes zorn und den tod förchten und nach der gerechtigkeit hungerig und dürstig sind. So wir aber uns selbs prüfen und ein jeder in sein aigen gewissen geen, wie uns der heilig Paulus leret, werden wir gewißlich nicht anders finden dann allerlei greuliche sünde und den tod, den wir mit der sünde verschuldt haben, und können doch uns selbs in keinen wege daraus helfen. Darumb hat unser lieber Herr Jesus Christus sich über uns erbarmt und ist umb unser sünden willen mensch worden, auf das er das gesetz und allen willen Gottes für uns und uns zu gut erfüllet und den tod und alles, was wir mit unsern sünden verschuldt hetten, für uns und zu unser erledigung auf sich neme und erlitte. Und das wir das je festiglich glaubten und durch den glauben frölich in seinem willen möchten leben, nam er nach dem abentmal das brot, saget dank, brachs und sprach: Nemet hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch dargegeben wird. Das ist: das ich mensch bin worden und alles, das ich tu und leide, ist alles euer aigen, für euch und euch zu gut geschehen. Des zu einem gewisen anzaigen und zeugnus gib ich euch mein leib zur speis. Desgleichen nam er auch den kelch und sprach: Nemet hin und trinket aus disem alle! Das ist der kelch des neuen testaments in meinem blut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wird zu vergebung der sünde. So oft ir das tut solt, ir mein darbei gedenken. Das ist: dieweil ich mich euer angenummen und euer sünde auf mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs für die sünde in tod opfern, mein blut vergießen, […] gnad und vergebung der sünde erwerben und also ein neu testament aufrichten, darinnen die sünde vergeben und ewig nicht mer soll gedacht werden. Des zu einem gewisen anzaigen und zeugnus gib ich euch mein blut zu trinken. Wer nun also von disem brot isset und von disem kelch trinket, auch disen worten, die er von Christo höret, und disen zaichen, die er von Christo empfahet, festiglich glaubt, der bleibt in dem Herrn Christo und Christus in ime und wird ewiglich leben. Darbei sollen wir nun sein gedenken und seinen tod verkündigen, nemlich das er für unser sünde sei gestorben und zu unser rechtfertigung wider auferstanden, und ime darumb danksagen, ein jeder sein kreuz auf sich nemen und ime nachfolgen und nach seinem gepot einander lieben, wie er uns geliebt hat: dann wir alle sind ein brot und ein leib, dieweil wir alle eines brots tailhaftig sind und aus einem kelch trinken.

Order of the Lord's Supper. When the priest will hold the Supper of the Lord (if he have communicants at all), he shall straightway make the following exhortation to the people, and then sing the words of the Supper, where the Mass is sung, about after the following manner and according to the notes set down hereafter; or, if he readeth the Mass, read them with loud and intelligible words, that they that stand about may hear them. The exhortation followeth. Dearly beloved in God, forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences, which confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else than all manner of horrible sins, and death, which we have deserved with sin, and yet can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. That is: that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token and witness thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. That is: forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token and witness thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth from Christ, and these signs which he receiveth from Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

**What 1533 changes in Osiander's text.**

- **"heilig abentmal"** (holy Supper) for "abentessen" (supper), and "darin er uns sein flaisch zu einer speis und sein blut zu einem trank, den glauben darmit zu sterken, gegeben hat" (wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith) for "nicht des leibs, sondern der selen" (not of the body but of the soul).
- **The comfort of consciences.** "dis heilig sacrament ist zu einem sundern trost und sterk geben den armen betrübten gewissen" (this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences) replaces the rule that only a hungry soul "soll … empfahen".
- **Self-examination expanded:** "und ein jeder in sein aigen gewissen geen" (and every one go into his own conscience) and "allerlei greuliche sünde" (all manner of horrible sins).
- **The work of Christ:** "das gesetz und allen willen Gottes … erfüllet" (fulfil the law and all the will of God), "zu unser erledigung" (for our deliverance).
- **"als wölt er sagen"** (as if he would say) becomes **"Das ist"** (That is) before each gloss.
- **"anzaigen und zeugnus"** (token and witness) for "warzaichen" (sign).
- **The ending.** "seinen tod verkündigen, nemlich das er für unser sünde sei gestorben und zu unser rechtfertigung wider auferstanden" (show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification) is added from Rom 4:25. Döber's closing wish is dropped.
- **No confession or absolution.** The Nürnberg editions from 1569 append the *Offene Schuld* (§3.4.4).

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540 | 3, pp. 69–70 | Verbatim except "itzt" for "jetzo" and "das abendmal" for "das heilig abentmal". Read after the consecration (Chapter 7 §7.12.6). |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, pp. 790–791 | Read on Saturdays and the eves of feasts "nach geschehener beicht und empfangener absolution" (after confession has been made and absolution received), so it begins "weil wir morgen das abentmal … halten wöllen" |

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| | | (forasmuch as we will tomorrow keep the Supper). "es ist solch sacrament … gegeben den armen, betrübten und zaghaftigen gewissen" (… and fainthearted consciences). |
| Regensburg, *Ein Christenliche vermanung, wie die zu Regenspurg alwegen vor der communion verlesen wird*, c. 1544 | 13, pp. 403–404 | "sein leib zur speis" (his body for meat) for "sein flaisch zu einer speis"; the cup-word in the Pauline form ("dieser kelch … solichs tut, so oft ihrs trinket, zu meinem gedechtnis"); "nach seinem bevelch" for "gepot". Printed as the exhortation "so alle sontag vor der communion daselbst geschicht" (that is made every Sunday before the communion). Followed by an open confession, "Gott sei mir sünder gnedig", and an indicative absolution ("verkündige ich euch solche vergebung"). The order of 1553 has it read at the altar by the second minister after the Creed, citing this text (Sehling 13, p. 420). |
| Regensburg, *Vermanung vor der communion*, 1567 | 13, pp. 404–405 | A new text on the same opening, "Ir geliebten in Gott! Dieweil wir jetzo das heilige abentmal unseres Herrn und Heilands Jesu Christi wöllen halten …", rewritten in three points (sin, Christ's fulfilment of the law, the bodily union with Christ in the Supper). It ends with the plural confession "Got sei uns armen sündern gnedig" and the absolution "Gott hat sich euer erbarmet … welche vergebung ich euch hiemit verkündige". |
| Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1543 and later editions | 11, p. 498 | Not reprinted: "wörtlich aus KO 1533". From 1569 the *Offene Schuld* with an indicative absolution is appended to it (§3.4.4) |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, pp. 72–73 | "die ire sünde empfinden und bekennen" (that feel and confess their sins); the cup-word lacks "das für euch und für vil vergossen wird zu vergebung der sünde". Text in Chapter 7 §7.14.1. |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, pp. 136–137 | South-western subgroup (below) |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15, pp. 69–70 | "das heylig hochwirdig sacrament des leibs und pluts unsers herren Jesu Christi wollen halten und empfangen" (will keep and receive the holy, most worthy sacrament of the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ) for "das heilig abentmal … bedenken und halten"; "disen worten … und diser gaben, so er … empfahet" (these words … and these gifts which he receiveth) for "disen zaichen" (these signs). The manuscript lacks the transition to the open confession. |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Marbach, 1553 | 20/1, p. 412 | South-western subgroup; begins "Lieben freundt, dieweyl wir jetz vermitelst gottlicher gnadenn das h. abentmall … haltenn wöllenn" (Dear friends, forasmuch as we will now, by means of divine grace, keep the holy Supper); read from the altar on Sundays between the psalms |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist) | 10, p. 151 | Incipit only, "Ir allerliebsten in Gott etc." |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 | 15, pp. 286–287 | Verbatim ("haben" for "hetten") |
| Erbach, *Kirchenordnung*, 1587 | 9, pp. 436–437 | South-western subgroup; "sein leib unnd blut zu einer geistlichen speise unnd tranck" (his body and blood for a spiritual meat and drink); "nachtmal" for "sacrament"; followed by the open confession |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 | 10, pp. 626–627 | Verbatim ("mit allem fleiß" for "mit großen fleiß") |

**The south-western subgroup.** Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Strasbourg 1553 and Erbach 1587 share a set of changes that mark them as one recension:

- "dieweil wir jetz das abentmal … halten wöllen", dropping "bedenken und" (consider and);
- "sein leib" (his body) for "sein flaisch" (his flesh);
- "und ein jeder in sein gewissen geht", dropping "wie uns der heilig Paulus leret";
- "das gesetz … für uns und uns zu gut erfüllet", dropping "und allen willen Gottes";
- "nam er im abentmal das brot" (he took the bread in the Supper) for "nach dem abentmal" (after the Supper);
- "und nach seinem gepot einander lieben, wie er uns geliebt hat, auch …" and "eines brots tailhaftig seyen".

Württemberg 1553 also reads "in dem Abendtmal", where Württemberg 1536 had followed Brandenburg-Nürnberg's "nach dem abentmal" (§3.5.6).

### 3.5.6 The Württemberg family, 1536 and 1553

**The archetype.** Württemberg 1536 takes the Brandenburg-Nürnberg text and expands it. It adds Augustine's sacraments as "sichtbarliche wort" (visible words), a stronger statement of the presence ("mein waren, wesenlichen leib", my true, essential body), and the Didache's figure of the grains and grapes. After it come the open confession, one of three absolutions, and the Our Father sung by the church (§3.4.4). **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, pp. 107–108):

> Ir allerliebsten in Christo Jesu, dieweil wir yetzund das gnadreich abentmal unsers liebsten heylands begeen und halten werden, Darinnen er uns sein warhafftigen leib zu einer speis unnd sein eigen blut zu einem dranck, den glauben damit zu stercken, gegeben hat, Sollen wir billich mit grossem fleis und inprünstiger andacht uns selbs, wie Sant Paulus vermanet, brüffen, Dann dieweil die armen, blöden gewissen eben sowol durch die gnadenreichen sacrament, die da sichtbarliche wort von Sant Augustin genant werden, als durch das wort, so zu dem er eingehet, vermittelst dem heiligen geyst getröst und gesterckt mögen werden, so ist das gnadenreich nachtmal zu einem sondern trost und stercke den betrübten geistern und zerschlagen hertzen geben, die ire sünd bekennen, Gottes gestrengen zorn und den grausamen todt fürchten unnd empfinden und nach der gerechtigkeyt hungerig seind. So wir aber unns selbs briefen unnd ein yeder in sein eigen gewissen gehen wirt, wie uns der heilig Apostel hie leeret, werden wir gewißlich nichts anders finden, dann allerley grosse, geferliche sünd unnd den erschrockenlichen tod, den wir mit der sünd verschult haben, unnd künden doch unns selbs in kein weg heraus helffen. Darumb hat unnser lieber herr Jesus Christus sich über uns erbarmet unnd ist umb unser sünd willen mensch worden, auff das er das gesatz und allen willen Gottes für uns erfüllet unnd den tod, auch alles, was wir mit unnser sünd verschult hetten, für uns zu ewiger erlösung auff sich neme und erlitte. Und das wir das ye vestigklich glauben und durch den glauben frölich und freuntlich in seinem willen möchten leben, nam er nach dem abentmal das brot, sagt danck, brachs und sprach: Nempt hin unnd esset, das ist mein leib, der für euch dargeben würdet; (das ist) das ich mensch bin worden und alles, das ich thue und leide, ist alles ewer eigen, für euch und euch zu gut geschehen, des zu einem gewissen wortzeichen, sigel unnd zeugknus gib ich euch hie mit dem brot mein waren, wesenlichen leib. Desgleichen nam er auch den kelch und sprach: Nemet hin und trincket alle daraus, das ist der kelch des newen testaments in meinem blut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirdt zu vergebung der sünden; so offt ir das thund, solt ir mein darbey gedencken; das ist, dieweil ich mich ewer angenommen und ewer sünd auff mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs für die sünd in todt opffern, mein blut vergiessen, gnad und vergebung der sünden erwerben unnd also ein new, ewig testament auffrichten, darinnen die sünd vergeben unnd ewig nimmermehr gedacht soll werden. Das zu einem sichern pfandt unnd ewiger zeugknus, gib ich euch mein eygen wesenlich unnd warhafftig blut zu trincken. Wer nun also von disem brot ysset und von disem kelch trincket, auch disen wortten, die ehr von Christo hie höret, unnd disen wortzeichen, die er von Christo empfacht, vestigklich glaubt, der bleibt in dem Herren Christo unnd Christus in ime und wirdt ewigklich leben. Darbey sollen wir nun sein gedencken unnd seinen tod verkündigen, namlich das er für unser sünd sey gestorben unnd zu unser rechtvertigung wider aufferstanden, und ime darumb dancksagen, ein yeder sein creutz auff sich nemmen unnd ime nachvolgen unnd nach seinem gebott einander lieben, wie er uns gelyebt hatt, dann wir alle seindt ein brott unnd eyn leyb, dieweyl wir alle eines brots theilhafftig sein und aus einem kelch trincken. Dann zu gleicherweis, wie aus vil börlin zusamen gekeltert ein wein unnd ein tranck fleußt unnd sich in einander menget, und aus vil kernlin ein meel gemalet, ein brot und kuch gebachen wirdt, also sollen wir alle, so durch den glauben Christo in geleibt sein, durch brüderliche lieb umb Christus, unsers liebsten heilands willen, der unns zuvor so hoch geliebt hat, alle ein leibe, tranck, kuchen und brot werden unnd solchs gegeneinander nit allein mit lären worten, so nit von hertzen gehn, sonder durch wercken und warheit, wie Johannis leeret, on allen trug, trewlich gegeneinander beweisen, Amen.

Dearly beloved in Christ Jesus, forasmuch as we will now celebrate and keep the gracious Supper of our dearest Saviour, wherein he hath given us his true body for a meat and his own blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly with great diligence and fervent devotion to examine ourselves, as Saint Paul exhorteth; for forasmuch as poor feeble consciences may be comforted and strengthened, by means of the Holy Ghost, as well through the gracious sacraments, which are called by Saint Augustine visible words, as through the word, so far as it entereth in, therefore the gracious Supper is given for a special comfort and strength to troubled spirits and broken hearts, which confess their sins, fear and feel God's strict wrath and dreadful death, and are hungry after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one shall go into his own conscience, as the holy apostle here teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else than all manner of great and perilous sin, and terrible death, which we have deserved with sin, and yet can in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us, and take upon himself and suffer death, and also all that we had deserved with our sin, for us unto eternal redemption. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully and gladly in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; (that is) that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, is all your own, done for you and for your good; for a sure sign, seal and witness thereof I give you here with the bread my true, essential body. Likewise he took also the cup and said: Take and drink ye all thereof, this is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins; as oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby; that is, forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new, everlasting testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall never more be remembered for ever. For a sure pledge and everlasting witness thereof I give you my own essential and true blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he here heareth from Christ and these signs which he receiveth from Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us; for we are all one bread and one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup. For in like manner as out of many grapes pressed together one wine and one drink floweth and is mingled together, and out of many grains one meal is ground, and one bread and cake is baked, so shall we all, that are incorporated into Christ by faith, through brotherly love, for the sake of Christ our dearest Saviour, who first loved us so highly, become all one body, drink, cake and bread, and show the same faithfully one toward another, not only with empty words that come not from the heart, but in deeds and in truth, as John teacheth, without all guile, Amen.

**The revision of 1553.** The Württemberg order of 1553 revised the text, and nearly every later witness follows the revision. It moves the text back toward Brandenburg-Nürnberg in some places and adds Johannine clauses in others:

- **Dropped:** the Augustine clause ("dieweil die armen, blöden gewissen … getröst und gesterckt mögen werden"); "wesenlichen" (essential) and "eygen wesenlich unnd warhafftig" with the body and blood; "sigel" (seal); "gestrengen" and "grausamen"; "und freuntlich".
- **Restored from Brandenburg-Nürnberg:** "diß heilig Sacrament ist zu einem sondern trost und stercke gegeben den armen, betrübten gwissen" (this holy Sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength to poor troubled consciences); "für uns und uns zu gut"; "zu unser erledigung".
- **Added:**
  - "die ire sünde im hertzen entpfinden unnd bekennen" (that feel their sins in the heart and confess them);
  - "dann der sold der sünden ist der tod, wie Paulus sagt" (for the wages of sin is death, as Paul saith; Rom 6:23);
  - with the bread: "und das ir immer in mir bleiben und leben unnd ich in euch" (and that ye may always abide and live in me and I in you; John 6:56);
  - with the cup: "und zur stercke und fürderung meines lebens in euch" (and for the strength and furtherance of my life in you);
  - "unnd dises Sacrament zu erinnerung und bestätigung seines glaubens entpfahet" (and receiveth this Sacrament for the remembrance and confirmation of his faith), replacing "disen wortzeichen, die er von Christo empfacht";
  - "im ewig lob und danck darumb sagen" (say to him everlasting praise and thanks therefor);
  - the closing doxology "Das helff uns der Almechtig, barmhertzig Gott und Vatter unsers lieben Herrn Jesu Christi durch seinen heiligen geist, Amen" (The almighty, merciful God and Father of our dear Lord Jesus Christ help us thereto through his Holy Ghost, Amen).
- **Changed:** "bezalete" (paid) for "erlitte" (suffered); "in dem Abendtmal" (in the Supper) for "nach dem abentmal"; "mit der that und warheit" (in deed and truth) for "durch wercken und warheit".

- **The editions of 1555 and after** (and Mömpelgard 1560, 1571) restore after "ein brott und ein leib" the clause "dweil wir alle eins brots teilhafftig seind und auß einem Kelch trincken" (Sehling 16, p. 253, apparatus). All the later witnesses have it.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560 | 19/1, pp. 176–177 | The **1536** text, but without the Augustine clause and without "wesenlichen"; "Ir allerliebsten in Gott"; "mit rechter andacht" for "inprünstiger"; "betrübten und bekümmerten hertzen"; ends at "eines brodts theilhafftig sind und aus einem kelch trincken", without the grains and grapes, and goes straight to the open confession |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16, pp. 252–253 | The revision |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 14, pp. 148–149 | 1553 text; drops "trewlich" at the end |
| Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 | 19/1, pp. 251–252 | 1553 text; "nichts anderß befinden"; "dancket" for "saget danck" |
| Lindau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 12, p. 208 | 1553 text; "sein bedenken" (remember him); "betrug" for "trug". Luther's paraphrase follows at the altar (§3.5.3). |
| Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 20/2, pp. 64–65 | 1553 text; "umb unsert willen" for "umb unser sünden willen" |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618 | 10, p. 275, apparatus | 1553 text recast for the **communion of the sick**: "Lieber Freund in Christo, dieweil ihr zu diesem mahl das gnadenreiche Abendmahl … zu empfangen begeret … so sollet ihr billich … euch selbsten … prüffen"; the cross and love of neighbour in the second person ("Ihr sollet auch ewer Creutz mit Gedult auff euch nehmen") |
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582 | 10, pp. 579–580 | 1553 text, shortened at the end: after "nicht allein mit wortenn sonder mit der that undt warheit" it closes with "dieweil wir alle eines brots theilhaftig seindt", without the grains and grapes |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, pp. 611–612 | 1553 text; drops "ein tranck fleußt und sich in einander menget" |
| Isny, *Agende*, c. 1600 | 17/1, pp. 459–460 | 1553 text; a later hand notes "vide Ulm kirchenordnung" |
| Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 | 9, pp. 361–362 | 1553 text with scriptural glosses added: "wie er selbst sagt Johannis am sechsten capitel"; "wie Sanct Paulus 1. Corinth. 10 sagt"; "seinen nechsten" for "einander" |
| Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603 | 19/2, pp. 618–619 | 1553 text, taken by way of Kurpfalz 1556 (editor's note) |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610 | 16, p. 620 | Incipit only, followed by "die vermahnung zur offentlichen Beicht" |

**What the revision means.** The 1553 reviser removed both the Augustinian language of signs and seals ("sichtbarliche wort", "wortzeichen", "sigel") and the strongest realist word ("wesenlichen leib"). In their place came the Johannine clauses of mutual indwelling and the Sacrament received "zu erinnerung und bestätigung seines glaubens". The orders that took the text over did not change it on either point.

### 3.5.7 The Bugenhagen family: Brunswick, 1528

**The archetype.** Bugenhagen's exhortation is read at the altar to the communicants, after the pulpit exhortation with its Creed, confession and general prayer (§3.4.4). **Brunswick, *Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 443–444):

> Exhortatio edder vormaninge vor dem altare vamme sacramente an de communicanten. Myne allerlevesten, uns wert stedes dorch de predige des evangelii Christi vohrgehoLden, dat wy van uns sulvest unweten, arme sundere unde vorlaren sind. Unde dewile wy nicht mehr van uns sulvest sind wen flesch unde blut, derwegen […] wy uns ock mit unseme vorstande unde vormogen nicht konen lös maken uth deme strengen richte Gades unde van der gewalt des düvels, darin wy gevallen synt dorch de overtredinge de gebade unde des willen Gades. So hefft Got unse unvormogen bet erkant wen wy unde hefft vor uns gegeven alse eyn gnedich Vader synen eyngebaren Sone Jesum Christum, dat wy dorch syn evangelion erluchtet unde dorch synen döt erlöset wurden van unsen sunden unde dorch em kyndere Gades weren, ewich salich, so wy dat löveden. Sulk let he uns stedes predigen, we dat lovet, de hefft gewisse dat ewige levent, up sulken loven unde to sulker salicheit werde wy ock gedofft, dar schole wy stedes inne bliven, so blive wy in Christo unde Christus in uns. So ete wy stedes ane underlät geistlick mitdeme loven dat lyff Christi unde drinken syn blut, dat is, wy werden Christo ingelivet, dat wy eyns mit em werden, darmede dat wy löven, dat he syn lyff vor uns in den döt gegeven hefft unde syn blut vor uns imme krütze vorgaten, darup vorlate wy uns tor salicheit wedder alle falsche lere, alle sunde, anvechtinge unde nöt. Uth welker woldät Christi wy ock leren, welke leve unde gedult wy öven scholen jegen unsen negesten, ock jegen unsen vyent. Wat wolde wy mehr ? Doch dat wy nicht vorgeten edder träch wurden (alse wy leyder werden) to sulkeme loven der mynschwerdinge unde dodes Christi, hefft he uns ock eyne besonderge gedechtnisse edder vorkundinge synes dodes, so vakene wy willen, bevalen, dat wy ock imme uthwendigen sacramente, der vornuft vorborgen, alleyne deme loven uth deme worde Christi bekant, eten scholen unde drinken syn liff unde blut, dat wy jo nicht twivelen scholen, syn döt unde blutvorgetinge imme krütze sy unse gewisse salicheit, darvan schole wy singen, lesen, predigen, hören, alse wy in der misse dohn, unde namals ock darvan reden unde mank eynander vorkundigen, uns to tröste unde velen tor salicheit nach deme bevehle Christi: Sulk doht to myner gedechtnisse. We nu werdich wil eten unde drinken dit sacramente, de schal twe dink dohn: he schal löven, wat Christus secht, unde dohn, wat he gebut. He secht: Dit is myn lyff, dat vor ju gegeven wert. Dit is myn blut, dat vor ju uthgegaten wert to vorgevinge der sunden. Sulk schole gy löven. He gebut overs: Nemet hen unde etet. Drinket alle daruth unde gedenket myner. Sulk schole gy dohn nach syner gnaden wort unde bevehl. Amen.

Exhortation or admonition before the altar concerning the sacrament, to the communicants. My dearly beloved, it is continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ that we of ourselves are ignorant, poor and lost sinners. And forasmuch as we of ourselves are no more than flesh and blood, therefore we can by no understanding or power of ours loose ourselves out of the strict judgment of God and from the power of the devil, wherein we are fallen through the transgression of the commandments and of the will of God. So God hath known our impotence better than we, and hath given for us, as a gracious Father, his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, that we might be enlightened through his Gospel, and redeemed from our sins through his death, and through him be children of God, eternally saved, if we believed it. This he letteth be preached to us continually: whoso believeth it, he hath surely eternal life; upon such faith and unto such salvation are we also baptized; therein shall we abide continually; so abide we in Christ and Christ in us. So eat we continually without ceasing, spiritually with faith, the body of Christ and drink his blood; that is, we are incorporated into Christ, that we become one with him, in that we believe that he hath given his body into death for us and shed his blood for us on the cross; thereupon we rely for salvation against all false teaching, all sin, temptation and need. Out of which benefit of Christ we also learn what love and patience we shall exercise toward our neighbour, yea, toward our enemy. What would we more? Yet that we might not forget nor grow slack (as, alas, we do) in such faith in the incarnation and death of Christ, he hath also commanded us a special remembrance or showing forth of his death, as oft as we will, that we shall also in the outward sacrament, hidden from reason, known to faith alone out of the word of Christ, eat and drink his body and blood; that we may in no wise doubt that his death and shedding of blood on the cross is our sure salvation; thereof shall we sing, read, preach, hear, as we do in the Mass, and afterward also speak thereof and show it forth among one another, for our comfort and for the salvation of many, according to the command of Christ: This do in remembrance of me. Whoso now will worthily eat and drink this sacrament, he shall do two things: he shall believe what Christ saith, and do what he commandeth. He saith: This is my body, which is given for you. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. That shall ye believe. But he commandeth: Take and eat. Drink ye all thereout, and remember me. That shall ye do according to his gracious word and command. Amen.

**Note.**

- **"Twe dink"** (two things), believing and doing, is the whole doctrine of worthy reception.

- **Two kinds of eating.** "So ete wy stedes … geistlick mitdeme loven" (so eat we continually … spiritually with faith) is the spiritual eating of John 6. The Sacrament is given in addition, "imme uthwendigen sacramente" (in the outward sacrament), so that we "jo nicht twivelen scholen" (may in no wise doubt).

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 530–531 | Low German, verbatim but for spelling ("solches" for "sulk") |
| Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 | 5, p. 530, apparatus | As Hamburg (variants in the Hamburg apparatus) |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 55–56 | Low German; "dorch de overtredinge der gebaden" (dropping "unde des willen Gades"); "unde ock darvan reden mank eynander unde unsen kinderen und gesinde" (and to our children and household); also offers Luther's paraphrase |
| Osnabrück, city and diocese, 1543 | 7/1, pp. 224, 258 | Incipit only, "Myn alderlevesten etc.", read after the Sanctus |
| Frankfurt, *Agende* for baptism and the communion of the sick, 1543 | 9, pp. 517–518 | A free High German paraphrase for the sick, "Ihr Allerliebste in Christo, unserm Herrn! Got lässet uns stetz durch sein heilig Wort predigen …" |
| Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 7/2.1, p. 854 | Incipit, with the editor's reference to Wolfenbüttel |
| Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 7/1, p. 75 | Incipit "Myn allerlevesten in Christo, uns wert stedes dorch de predige des evangelii" |
| Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung* "von 1526" | 5, p. 468 | Incipit only, "Mine allerlevesten etc.", read by the priest to the communicants after the sermon, before the Preface |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 562 | Incipit "Mine allerlevesten, uns wert stedes dorch die predige des evangelii vorgedregen etc." |
| Hildesheim (Steuerwald and Peine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1561 | 7/2.1, p. 782 | Incipit, "die Exhortationem Pomerani, in der brunschwigischen kirchenordenung vorzaichnet" (Pomeranus's exhortation, set down in the Brunswick church order) |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 547–548 | **High German translation**, "Ein ander exhortation" after the Osiander text (§3.5.4) |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, p. 147 | High German, as Lüneburg |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, p. 413 | High German, as Lüneburg, but skipping by homoeoteleuton from "gericht Gottes" to "so hat Gott" |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571, communion of the sick | 21, pp. 428–429 | High German, ascribed to "D. Mart. Lutheri"; "des heiligen Evangelii … fürgetragen"; drops "auch gegen unsern feinden"; "eusserlichen" for "auswendigen" |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, p. 159 | High German, as Lüneburg |
| Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613 | 7/1, p. 269 | High German, **abridged and recast** (below) |

**The High German recension.** Lüneburg 1564 translates the Low German text closely: "Mein allerliebsten, uns wird stets durch die predigt des evangelii Christi fürgehalten, das wir von uns selbs unwissen, arme sünders und verloren sein …" (Sehling 6/1, p.

547). Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Lippe 1571 and Verden 1606 copy the Lüneburg translation, not the Low German.

**Osnabrück 1613: the abridgement.** The Osnabrück order of 1613 cuts the exhortation to half its length. It drops the passage on spiritual eating ("So ete wy stedes ane underlät geistlick …") and replaces the account of sacramental eating with a statement of oral reception. **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613** (Sehling 7/1, p. 269):

> Mein allerliebste, dieweil wir von uns selbst nichts dann fleisch und blut sein und können uns auß dem strengen gericht Gottes, darein wir gefallen seind, nicht loß machen, so hat Gott als ein gnädiger Vatter seinen eingebornen Sohn Jesum Christum für uns gegeben, daß wir durch seinen todt vom ewigen todt erlöset und also durch ihn kinder Gottes würden, ewig selig, so wir an ihn glauben. Auf solchen glauben und zu solcher seligkeit werden wir getauft, davon wird uns auch stäts gepredigt. Und damit wir nicht vergessen oder träg werden im glauben, lieb und gedult, als wir leider oft werden, so hat er ein besonder gedechtnusse und verkündigung seines todts befohlen, daß wir im außwendigen sacrament auf Christi befehl mit unserm leiblichen mund vermittelst deß gesegneten brots in einem hohen, der vernunft verborgenen geheimnuß essen sollen unsers Herrn Jesu Christi leib, den er für uns in den todt gegeben hat, und trinken auß dem gesegneten kelch sein blut, das er vor uns vergossen hat, und sollen von seinem todt und blutvergiessung singen, lesen, predigen und hören nach dem befehl Christi: Solches tut zu meinem gedechtnuß.

My dearly beloved, forasmuch as we of ourselves are nothing but flesh and blood, and cannot loose ourselves out of the strict judgment of God, into which we are fallen, God as a gracious Father hath given for us his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, that through his death we might be redeemed from eternal death and so through him become children of God, eternally saved, if we believe on him. Upon such faith and unto such salvation are we baptized; thereof also is continually preached unto us. And that we may not forget nor grow slack in faith, love and patience, as, alas, we often do, he hath commanded a special remembrance and showing forth of his death: that in the outward sacrament, at Christ's command, we should eat with our bodily mouth, by means of the blessed bread, in a high mystery hidden from reason, the body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which he hath given into death for us, and drink out of the blessed cup his blood, which he hath shed for us; and should sing, read, preach and hear of his death and shedding of blood, according to the command of Christ: This do in remembrance of me.

The ending, "Wer nun würdig wil essen und trinken diß sacrament, der sol zwey ding tun …", follows Bugenhagen's text. Sehling's editor: "Es handelt sich im wesentlichen um die Vermahnung Bugenhagens … Doch ist die Exhortation hier straffer zusammengefaßt und verkürzt" (It is in essence Bugenhagen's exhortation … but here it is more tightly summarized and shortened).

**What the family shows.** Bugenhagen's text was transmitted in two languages, but the High German form is a single translation, made once (Lüneburg 1564) and copied. Only Osnabrück 1613 rewrote its doctrine, replacing the spiritual eating of John 6 with the oral eating "mit unserm leiblichen mund vermittelst deß gesegneten brots".

#### 3.5.8 The Naumburg family, 1537

**The archetype.** The order for St. Wenzel's at Naumburg has a short exhortation of its own, read while the choir sings and the communicants gather in the choir, and followed by the German Sanctus. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 80):

> Und dieweil der ganze chor also singet, sollen sich die communicanten in den chor vorsamlen, so soll dan der priester eine vormanung an sie thun wie volget. Lieben freunde, dieweil ihr itzund das testament unsers lieben herrn Jesu Christi zu halten und empfahen vorsamlet seit, so vormane ich euch, das ihr der teuren gaben und gnaden, die uns unser lieber herr Jesus Christus hierinnen bescheiden und geschenket hat, eben warnehmen woltet, dieselben mit hohem vleis betrachten und ihme darumb danken, und ein jeder wolle sich selber hierinnen briefen, auf das er wirdig von dem brot und kelch, welches ist des herrn leib und blut, esse und trinke, also das er wisse, das ihme dis zu vorgebung seiner sunden zu trost und sterk seines glaubens vom herrn gegeben sei, und darnach auch hingehe und Christo unserm lieben herrn und gott zue lob und dank, seinem nehestem in warhaftiger lieb und treu nach allem vermugen diene, gleich wie uns Christus hiemit gedienet hat, das er uns durch sein heiliges bitteres leiden und sterben vom ewigem tode erloset und kinder des ewigen lebens gemacht hat. Auf diese vormanung singet der ganze chor das sanctus

And while the whole choir thus singeth, the communicants shall gather in the choir, and then the priest shall make an exhortation to them, as followeth. Dear friends, forasmuch as ye are now gathered to keep and receive the testament of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, I admonish you that ye would take good heed of the precious gifts and graces which our dear Lord Jesus

Christ hath bequeathed and given us herein, consider them with high diligence and give him thanks therefor; and that every one would examine himself herein, that he may worthily eat and drink of the bread and cup, which is the Lord's body and blood, so that he may know that this is given him by the Lord for the forgiveness of his sins and for the comfort and strength of his faith; and that thereafter he would go forth and, to the praise and thanks of Christ our dear Lord and God, serve his neighbour in true love and faithfulness according to all his power, even as Christ hath served us herewith, in that he hath redeemed us from eternal death by his holy, bitter passion and death, and made us children of eternal life. Upon this exhortation the whole choir singeth the Sanctus.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544 | 12, p. 312 | Prescribes "eine kurze vermanung" (a short exhortation) to the communicants, followed by the German Sanctus, as at Naumburg, but does not print it. The editor of Nördlingen 1579 takes it to be the Naumburg text, "schon durch Löner nach Nördlingen gebracht" (brought to Nördlingen already by Löner). |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579 | 12, pp. 369–370 | Full (below) |

**Nördlingen 1579.** The text is read "vor dem altar, uf welchem das nachtmal ausgeteilet" (before the altar on which the Supper is distributed), after the Our Father. Sehling's editor: "Nicht aus Württemberg 1553, wo die Nürnberger Abendmahlsvermahnung gebracht ist, sondern aus der Naumburger Kirchenordnung (Sehling 2, 80)" (Not from Württemberg 1553, where the Nürnberg exhortation is given, but from the Naumburg church order). Its changes:

- **The address** "Geliebten in Christo Jesu!" (Beloved in Christ Jesus!) for "Lieben freunde".
- **"des Herrn leib und bluet"** in parentheses, and "uf das er würdig werde" (that he may become worthy).
- **"von sunden und ewigem tode erlöset"** (redeemed from sins and eternal death).
- **A transition to the Verba**, sung in German after it: "Wie aber Christus sein abentmal gehalten und was er uns dabei zu glauben und zu tun bevolhen hat, werdet ir aus volgenden worten weiter vernemen" (But how Christ kept his Supper, and what he hath commanded us to believe and to do therein, ye shall further learn from the following words; Sehling 12, p. 370).

### 3.5.9 The Mecklenburg family, 1552

**The archetype.** The Mecklenburg order makes the exhortation a short summary of repentance and faith, with a conditional, indicative absolution, a call to thanksgiving and intercession, and a long prayer in the first person singular for each communicant to make his own. It is read after the Preface and Sanctus, "so man zeit hat" (if there is time). **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 202–204):

> Vermanung: Absolutio, danksagung und gebet vor der communio. Lieben freunde, ir als christliche menschen, die ir zuvor bericht habt von gott, von gottes ernstlichen willen und gesetz, von der menschlichen natur erschaffung, und ernach von unser sünde, und von der erlösung durch den heiland Jesum Christum, und von allen artickeln des glaubens, und warhaftiglich die selbigen gleubet, erscheinet allhie und komet zu diesem hohen trost, den uns der herr Christus in niessung seines leibs und bluts gibet, nu wisset ir den eid des allmechtigen ewigen gottes, darin er spricht, so war ich lebe, ich will nicht, das der sünder sterbe, sondern das er bekeret werde und das leben habe. Diesen eid hat gott mit seines eingebornen sons Jesu Christi blut, tod und ufferstehung bekreftiget, und ist beides darin gefasset, die bekerung und vergebung der sünden. Gott hat geschworn, das sein will ist, das wir nicht in sünden wider gewissen bleiben sollen, sondern sollen uns zu im bekeren, fur seinem gerechten zorn erschrecken, und herzlichen schmerzen haben, von wegen unsers ungehorsams und unser undankarkeit und schreckliche verachtung gegen im. Wer nu ein solch herz bringet, wie gott selb spricht, er wolle wonen in den zerschlagnen herzen, und die sein wort fürchten, die selbigen sollen die grosse gnaden , die uns um des herrn Christi willen geschenkt wird, betrachten, begeren und annemen, und sollen festiglich gleuben, das inen alle sünd, um des herrn Christi willen, aus gnaden, one unsere verdienst vergeben sind, so sie diesen trost mit glauben und vertrauen uff den herrn Christum annemen, und sollen nicht im zweivel stecken bleiben, sondern warhaftiglich schliessen, das sie also vergebung der sünden empfahen, und gott gefellig und erben ewiger selikeit sind, und das der herr Christus gewislich inen seinen heiligen geist geben wil, und das gott in inen gnediglich wonen, sie

> regieren und bewaren wil zu ewiger selikeit, und sollen also forthin in glauben und gutem gewissen im gehorsam sein. Dieses alles solt ir teglich betrachten, und sonderlich so ir zur niessung des leibs und bluts unsers herrn Christi komet, da erinnert uns unser herr Christus beides, nemlich, das gottes zorn so gros ist wider unsere sünd , das er nicht anders hat sollen versünet werden, denn allein durch den gehorsam und tod seines allerliebsten sons, das er auch gewislich alle, die bekeret werden und uff den son vertrauen, gnediglich annimet. Und zum gewissen zeugnis dieses seinen unwandelbaren willens hat der herr Christus diese ordnung eingesetzt, das er uns mit diesen eusserlichen sichtbaren dingen gewislich seinen warhaftigen leib und blut gibet, und bestetiget hiemit seine zusag, das uns die sünden gewislich um seines leidens willen vergeben werden, und das er warhaftiglich bei uns sein und in uns wirken wolle, wie er spricht: Ich bin in inen, und ich gebe inen ewiges leben. Derhalben allen, die also hie erscheinen, die sich zu gott bekeren, und fur gottes zorn wider ire sünd erschrecken, und gleuben, das inen um des herrn Christi willen ire sünd vergeben werden, und haben fursatz von sünden wider gewissen abzulassen, denen verkünde ich vergebung der sünden, laut der wort Christi, Welchen ir die sünde vergebet , denen sind sie vergeben, derhalben aus befehl des herrn Christi sprich ich euch diese absolutio, das euch eure sünd vergeben sind, um des herrn Christi willen, und diese stimme des evangelii solt ir annemen, und am herrn Christo warhaftigen trost haben, und forthin im glauben und gutem gewissen gott gehorsam sein. Und zum zeugnis, das euch selb diese gnad geschenkt und adplicirt wird, solt ir den leib und das blut des herrn Jesu Christi empfahen, und wissen, das der herr Christus am creuz ein opfer fur euch gewesen ist, und hat seinen leib fur euch geben und sein blut fur euch vergossen, und das der herr Christus euch zu seinen gliedmassen machet und wil in euch kreftig sein. Hie solt ir auch dem allmechtigen gott, vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, und dem herrn Jesu Christo fur solche grosse gnaden danken und trost und freude am herrn Christo haben, denn er wil bei euch sein, euch regiern und bewaren, ir solt auch hiebei euer herzlich gebet thun fur gemeine kirchen und herrschaft fur euch und fur eure kindlin. Allmechtiger warhaftiger gott, ewiger und einiger vater unsers heilands Jesu Christi, samt deinem einigen son Jesu Christo und heiligen geist, erschaffer aller creaturen, der du weise, warhaftig, gütig, gerecht, keusch und richter bist und zürnest wider die sünd, ich bekenne, das ich leider viel sünde an mir habe, und habe dazu viel sünde wissentlich und unwissentlich gethan, und ist mir herzlich leid, das ich dich warhaftigen gott erzürnet hab, und bitte dich, du wollest mir durch deine grosse barmherzigkeit um deines allerliebsten sons Jesu Christi willen alle meine sünde vergeben, mir gnedig sein, und mich um des herrn Christi willen und durch in gerecht und dir wolgefellig machen, und wollest mich mit deinem heiligen geist erleuchten, reinigen und regiern. Ich gleube auch deinem heiligen evangelio und deiner gnedigen verheissung, darin du uns um deines lieben sons Jesu Christi willen vergebung der sünden, gerechtikeit und ewiges leben zusagest, und bitte dich, du wollest mein herz im glauben und in erkentnis deines lieben sons sterken. Ich danke dir auch, allmechtiger gott, fur alle wolthat, und sonderlich dass du dich gnediglich uns geoffenbart hast, und hast uns deinen lieben son zu mittler und versüner für uns verordnet, und uns durch in vom ewigen zorn errettet und widerum zu ewiger selikeit angenomen. Und bitte dich, du wollest um deines sons Jesu Christi willen uns armen elenden schwachen menschen gnedig sein, und dir fur und fur unter uns ein ewige kirche samlen, und diese lande und herrschaft bewaren, und uns frieden und selige regiment geben, und mich und meine arme kindlin gnediglich regiern und behüten, amen. Auch danke ich dir, allmechtiger eingeborner son gottes, Jesu Christe, das du aus grosser liebe gegen der armen menschlichen creatur für uns gebeten hast, und hast menschliche natur an dich genomen, damit nicht die menschen ganz in ewikeit verworfen würden, sondern durch dich widerum von sünden errett, und zu ewiger gerechtikeit und ewigem leben gebracht würden, und hast den grossen unaussprechlichen zorn der göttlichen maiestet, wider unsere sünde, von uns schwachen menschen uff dich gewand, in allen deinem gehorsam, leiden und sterben, und bist widerum vom tod erstanden, und bleibest mittler und furbitter fur uns, und samlest dir ein ewige kirche, durch dein evangelium und heiligen geist, und bist Emmanuel, das ist gott mit uns, gibest ewige selikeit allen, die zu dir bekeret werden, und gleuben, das inen gott um deines leidens und deiner vorbit willen gnedig sei , und wilt gewislich diese arme schwache menschen in deiner kirchen bewaren. Ich bitte dich mit herzlichen seufzen, du wollest mir gnedig sein, und alle meine sünde vergeben, und deinen ewigen vater fur mich bitten und mir deinen heiligen geist geben, mich regiern und bewaren wider deine feinde, nemlich, wider die gotteslesterige, lügenhaftige, unreine teufel. Auch wollestu allmechtiger gottes son Jesu Christe, der du am creuz gestorben bist, und am dritten tag widerum lebendig ufferstanden, und bist gerecht, warhaftig, keusch und barmherzig, dir für und für unter uns ein ewige kirche samlen, und diese land und herrschaft bewaren, und uns frieden und selige regiment geben, und mich und meine arme kindlin gnediglich regieren und behüten, amen.

Exhortation: absolution, thanksgiving and prayer before the communion. Dear friends, ye that as Christian men have been instructed beforehand concerning God, concerning God's earnest will and law, concerning the creation of man's nature, and thereafter concerning our sin, and concerning the redemption through the Saviour Jesus Christ, and concerning all the articles of the faith, and truly believe the same, appear here and come to this high comfort which the Lord Christ giveth us in the eating

of his body and blood. Now ye know the oath of the almighty, eternal God, wherein he saith: As I live, I will not the death of the sinner, but that he be converted and have life. This oath God hath confirmed with the blood, death and resurrection of his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ, and both are comprehended therein, conversion and forgiveness of sins. God hath sworn that it is his will that we shall not remain in sins against conscience, but shall turn to him, be terrified before his righteous wrath, and have hearty sorrow for our disobedience and our unthankfulness and dreadful contempt toward him. Whoso now bringeth such a heart (as God himself saith, he will dwell in the broken hearts and in them that fear his word), the same shall consider, desire and receive the great grace which is given us for the Lord Christ's sake, and shall firmly believe that all sins are forgiven them for the Lord Christ's sake, of grace, without our merit, if they receive this comfort with faith and trust in the Lord Christ; and shall not remain stuck in doubt, but truly conclude that they so receive forgiveness of sins, and are pleasing to God and heirs of eternal blessedness, and that the Lord Christ will surely give them his Holy Ghost, and that God will graciously dwell in them, govern and preserve them unto eternal blessedness; and they shall so henceforth be in obedience to him in faith and good conscience. All this ye shall consider daily, and especially when ye come to the eating of the body and blood of our Lord Christ; there our Lord Christ putteth us in mind of both, namely that God's wrath against our sin is so great that he could not be reconciled otherwise than only by the obedience and death of his dearest Son, and also that he surely receiveth graciously all that are converted and trust in the Son. And for a sure witness of this his unchangeable will the Lord Christ hath instituted this ordinance, that with these outward visible things he surely giveth us his true body and blood, and confirmeth herewith his promise that our sins are surely forgiven us for the sake of his passion, and that he will truly be with us and work in us, as he saith: I am in them, and I give them eternal life. Therefore unto all that so appear here, that turn to God, and are terrified before God's wrath against their sin, and believe that their sins are forgiven them for the Lord Christ's sake, and have the purpose to leave off sins against conscience, unto them I declare forgiveness of sins, according to the words of Christ, Whose soever sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them; therefore by the command of the Lord Christ I speak unto you this absolution, that your sins are forgiven you for the Lord Christ's sake; and this voice of the Gospel ye shall receive, and have true comfort in the Lord Christ, and henceforth be obedient to God in faith and good conscience. And for a witness that this grace is given and applied to you yourselves, ye shall receive the body and the blood of the Lord Jesus Christ, and know that the Lord Christ hath been a sacrifice for you on the cross, and hath given his body for you and shed his blood for you, and that the Lord Christ maketh you his members and will be mighty in you. Here ye shall also give thanks to the almighty God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the Lord Jesus Christ, for such great graces, and have comfort and joy in the Lord Christ, for he will be with you, govern and preserve you; ye shall also here make your hearty prayer for the common Church and government, for yourselves and for your little children. Almighty, true God, eternal and only Father of our Saviour Jesus Christ, together with thine only Son Jesus Christ and the Holy Ghost, Creator of all creatures, who art wise, true, good, just, chaste and a judge, and art wroth against sin: I confess that I, alas, have much sin in me, and have moreover done much sin, knowingly and unknowingly, and it is heartily grievous unto me that I have angered thee, the true God; and I pray thee that thou wouldest forgive me all my sins through thy great mercy, for the sake of thy dearest Son Jesus Christ, be gracious unto me, and make me righteous and well-pleasing unto thee for the Lord Christ's sake and through him, and enlighten, cleanse and govern me with thy Holy Ghost. I believe also thy holy Gospel and thy gracious promise, wherein thou promisest us forgiveness of sins, righteousness and eternal life for the sake of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, and I pray thee that thou wouldest strengthen my heart in faith and in the knowledge of thy dear Son. I thank thee also, almighty God, for all benefits, and especially that thou hast graciously revealed thyself to us, and hast ordained thy dear Son to be mediator and propitiator for us, and through him hast rescued us from eternal wrath and received us again unto eternal blessedness. And I pray thee that for thy Son Jesus Christ's sake thou wouldest be gracious unto us poor, wretched, weak men, and gather unto thyself evermore among us an eternal Church, and preserve these lands and this government, and give us peace and blessed rule, and graciously govern and keep me and my poor little children, amen. I thank thee also, almighty only-begotten Son of God, Jesus Christ, that out of great love toward the poor human creature thou hast prayed for us, and hast taken human nature upon thee, that men might not be wholly cast away for ever, but through thee be rescued again from sins and brought to eternal righteousness and eternal life; and hast turned the great, unspeakable wrath of the divine majesty against our sins from us weak men upon thyself, in all thy obedience, passion and death, and art risen again from death, and abidest mediator and intercessor for us, and gatherest unto thyself an eternal Church through thy Gospel and Holy Ghost, and art Emmanuel, that is, God with us, givest eternal blessedness to all that are converted to thee and believe that God is gracious to them for the sake of thy passion and thy intercession, and wilt surely preserve these poor weak men in thy Church. I pray thee with hearty sighs that thou wouldest be gracious unto me, and forgive all my sins, and pray thine eternal Father for me, and give me thy Holy Ghost, govern and preserve me against thine enemies, namely against the blasphemous, lying, unclean devils. And mayest thou, almighty Son of God, Jesus Christ, who didst die on the cross and on the third day didst rise again alive, and art just, true, chaste and merciful, gather unto thyself evermore among us an eternal Church, and preserve

this land and this government, and give us peace and blessed rule, and graciously govern and keep me and my poor little children, amen.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 | 18, pp. 189–190 | Verbatim, under the same heading. The Zweibrücken hymnal of 1571/1587 prints the section for the people and introduces the prayer with "so mans an der zeit haben kan, mag man auch volgendes gebett hinzu thun" (if one can have it in the time, one may also add the following prayer). |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 | 10, pp. 264–266 | Verbatim in 1576; replaced in the *Agende* of 1618 (below) |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1, pp. 406–408 | Taken from Pfalz-Zweibrücken (editor's note); "christlichen" added to "Christliche menschen"; ends after the call to thanksgiving, with the rubric for the Our Father and Verba in place of the prayer |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 501 | The prayer only, turned into the first person plural ("Wir bekhennen ja, herr, das wir vil sünde an uns haben, seind von Natur sündhafft und unrein …"), after Pfalz-Veldenz's own exhortation (§3.5.11) |

**Nassau-Weilburg 1618: the abridged recension.** The Nassau-Weilburg *Agende* of 1618 replaces the text with a shorter form. It is addressed to those "die ihr euch gestern habt angezeigt" (who announced yourselves yesterday), recalls "der Vermahnung, so gestern an euch geschehen" (the exhortation made to you yesterday), and keeps the conditional absolution. It then adds a passage on the Words of Institution and ends with the *Sursum corda*. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618, from Sehling's apparatus to the order of 1576** (Sehling 10, p. 264):

> Daß ihr diese Wort mit rechtem, wahren Glauben fasset und nicht zweiffelt, sondern festiglich glaubet, so gewiß der Sohn Gottes euch laut seiner eigenen Verheissung im Abendmahl speiset und trdäncket mit seinem eigenen Leib und Blut, Also gewiß unnd warhafftig ubergibt er auch euch unnd einem jedern insonderheit alle die Geistlichen Wolthaten, so er mit Auffopfferung seines Leibs und Vergiessung seines thewren Bluts seiner lieben Christenheit verdienet und erworben hat, Als da ist Vergebung der Sünden, Gerechtigkeit, die vor Gott gilt, und nach diesem Leben das ewig selig Leben. Endtlich sollt ihr auch hierbey ewer Gebet thun zu Gott vor die Noth der gantzen Christenheit, vor ewre liebe Obrigkeit, vor euch und vor ewre Kindlein. So erhebet nun ewere Hertzen zu Gott, unserem Herren, denn es ist billich und recht, auch heylsam, daß wir an allen Orthen unnd zu aller Zeit unseren Himmlischen Vatter unnd Heyligen Gott anruffen durch Jesum Christum, unseren Heyland.

That ye lay hold of these words with right, true faith and doubt not, but firmly believe: as surely as the Son of God, according to his own promise, feedeth you in the Supper and giveth you to drink with his own body and blood, so surely and truly doth he also deliver to you and to every one in particular all the spiritual benefits which he hath merited and obtained for his dear Christendom by the offering of his body and the shedding of his precious blood, such as forgiveness of sins, the righteousness that availeth before God, and after this life the eternal, blessed life. Lastly ye shall also here make your prayer to God for the need of all Christendom, for your dear government, for yourselves and for your little children. Lift up therefore your hearts unto God, our Lord, for it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times call upon our heavenly Father and holy God through Jesus Christ, our Saviour.

### 3.5.10 The Palatinate family, 1563

**The archetype.** The Reformed Palatinate order of Elector Frederick III (1563) has the longest exhortation in the corpus. It is read "bey dem tisch" (at the table) after the sermon and the Sunday prayer. It follows Geneva 1563 (Reformed) almost word for word at the beginning, and draws on London 1565 (à Lasco and Micron, Reformed) for the threefold examination and the fencing of the table, and on Kurpfalz 1556 (the Württemberg text) for the grains and grapes. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, pp. 383–386):

Ir geliebten in dem herrn Jesu Christo, höret an die wort der einsatzung deß heiligen abendmals unsers herrn Jesu Christi, welche uns beschreibet der heilig apostel Paulus in der ersten epistel an die Corint. am XI. capitel [23-29]: Ich hab es von dem herrn empfangen, daß ich euch gegeben hab. Denn der herr Jesus, in der nacht, da er verrahten ward, nam er das brod, dancket und brachs und sprach: Nemet, esset, das ist mein leib, der für euch gebrochen wird. Solchs thut zu meiner gedechtnuß. Desselbengleichen auch den kelch nach dem abendmal und sprach: Dieser kelch ist das neue testament in meinem blut. Solchs thut, so oft irs trinckt, zu meiner gedechtnuß. Denn so oft ir von diesem brod esset und von diesem kelch trincket, solt ihr des herrn todt verkündigen, biß daß er kompt. Welcher nun unwirdig von diesem brodt isset oder von dem kelch des herrn trincket, der ist schuldig an dem leib und blut deß herrn. Der mensch prüfe aber sich selbs und also esse er von disem brod und trincke von disem kelch. Denn welcher unwürdig ißet und trincket, der ißet und trincket im selber das gericht, damit daß er nicht underscheidet den leib deß herrn. Auf daß wir nun zu unserm trost des herrn nachtmal mögen halten, ist uns vor allen dingen vonnöten, daß wir uns zuvor recht prüfen, zum andern, daß wir es dahin richten, darzu es der herr Christus verordnet hat, nemlich zu seiner gedechtnuß. Die ware prüfung unser selbs stehet in diesen dreyen stücken, zum ersten bedenck ein jeder bei sich selbst seine sünd und vermaledeyung, auf daß er im selbst mißfalle und sich für Gott demütige, dieweil der zorn Gottes wider die sünd also groß ist, daß er dieselbige, ehe denn er sie ungestraft ließ hingehen, an seinem lieben son Jesu Christo mit dem bittern und schmehlichen tod des creutzes gestraft hat. Zum andern erforsche ein jeder sein hertz, ob er auch diser gewissen verheissung Gottes glaube, daß im alle seine sünd allein umb des leiden und sterben Jesu Christi willen vergeben sind und die volkommene gerechtigkeyt Christi ime als sein eigen zugerechnet und geschenckt sey, als wann er selbst in eigener person für alle seine sünde bezalet und alle gerechtigkeyt erfüllet hette. Zum dritten erforsche ein jeder sein gewissen, ob er auch gesinnet sey, forthin mit seinem gantzen leben Gott, dem herrn, sich danckbar zu erzeigen und für dem angesicht Gottes aufrichtig zu wandlen, ob er auch one alle gleißnerey aller feindschaft, neid und haß von hertzen absage und einen ernstlichen fursatz habe, hernachmals in warer lieb und einigkeyt mit seinem nechsten zu leben. Die nun also gesinnet sein, die wil Gott gewißlich zu gnaden annemen und für würdige tischgenossen seins sons Jesu Christi erkennen. Dargegen aber, die dieses zeugnuß in irem hertzen nicht empfinden, die essen und trincken inen selbst das gericht. Derhalben wir auch nach dem befelch Christi und des apostels Pauli alle, die sich mit nachvolgenden lastern behaftet wissen, von dem tisch des herrn abmanen und inen verkündigen, das sie kein theil am reich Christi haben, als da sind alle abgöttische, alle, so verstorbene heiligen, engel oder andere creaturen anrüfen, die bilder verehren, alle zauberer und warsager, die viehe und leuth sampt andern dingen segnen, und, die solchen segen glauben geben, alle verächter Gottes und seins worts und der heiligen sacramenten, alle gottslesterer, alle, die spaltung und meueterey in kirchen und weltlichem regiment begeren anzurichten, alle meineidigen, alle, die iren eltern und oberkeyten ungehorsam sind, alle todtschläger, balger, haderer, die in neid und haß wider ihren nechsten leben, alle ehebrecher, hurer, follsäufer, dieb, wucherer, rauber, spiler, geitzigen und alle die, so ein ergerlichs leben führen. Diese alle, so lang sie in solchen lastern beharren, sollen gedencken und sich diser speiß, welche Christus allein seinen gläubigen verordnet hat, enthalten, auf daß nit ir gericht und verdamnuß desto schwerer werde. Diß aber wirdt uns nicht fürgehalten, lieben christen, die zerschlagen hertzen der gläubigen kleinmütig zu machen, als ob niemands zum abendmal des herrn gehen möchte, dann die one alle sünde weren. Denn wir kommen nicht zu diesem abendmal, damit zu bezeugen, daß wir volkommen und gerecht seind in uns selbst, sonder dargegen, weil wir unser leben ausserhalb uns in Jesu Christo suchen, bekennen wir, daß wir mitten in dem todt ligen. Derhalben, wiewol wir noch viel gebrechen und elends in uns befinden, als da ist, daß wir nicht einen volkommenen glauben haben, daß wir uns auch nicht mit solchem eyfer, Gott zu dienen, begeben, wie wir zu thun schuldig sein, sonder täglich mit der schwachheyt unsers glaubens und bösen lüsten unsers fleisches haben zu streiten, nicht desto weniger, weil durch die gnad des heiligen geists solche gebrechen uns von hertzen leyd sind und wir unserm unglauben widerstand zu thun und nach allen geboten Gottes zu leben hertzlich begeren, sollen wir gewiß und sicher sein, daß keine sünd noch schwacheyt, so noch wider unsern willen in uns uberig ist, hindern kan, daß uns Gott nit zu gnaden anneme und also dieser himmlischen speiß und tranck würdig und theilhaftig mache. Zum andern laßt uns nun auch betrachten, warzu uns der herr sein abendmal hab eingesetzt, nemlich daß wir solches thun zu seiner gedechtnuß. Also sollen wir aber seins darbey gedencken, erstlich, daß wir gentzlich in unserm hertzen vertrauen, das unser herr Jesus Christus laut der verheissungen, welche den ertzvätern von anbegin geschehen, vom vater in dise welt gesandt sey, unser fleisch und blut an sich genommen, den zorn Gottes, under dem wir ewiglich hetten müssen versincken, von anfang seiner menschwerdung biß zum end seines lebens auf erden für uns getragen und allen gehorsam des göttlichen gesetz und gerechtigkeyt für uns erfüllet, fürnemlich da im der last unserer sünden und des zorns Gottes den blutigen schweiß im garten außgetrucket hat, da er ist gebunden worden, auf daß er uns entbünde, darnach unzälige schmach erlitten, auf daß wir nimmer zu schanden würden, unschuldig zum todt verurtheilt, auf daß wir für dem gericht Gottes freygesprochen würden, je seinen gebenedeiten leib ans creutz lassen neglen, auf daß er die handtschrift unser sünden daran neglete und hat also die

> vermaledeyung von uns auf sich geladen, auf daß er uns mit seiner benedeiung erfüllet, und hat sich genidriget biß in die allertiefeste schmach und hellische angst leibs und der seelen am stammen des creutzes, da er schrey mit lauter stimme: Mein Gott, mein Gott, warumb hastu mich verlassen [Mt. 27, 46], auf daß wir zu Gott genommen und nimmermehr von im verlassen würden, endlich mit seinen todt und blutvergiessen das neue und ewige testament, den bund der gnaden und versönung beschlossen, wie er gesagt hat: Es ist vollbracht [Joh. 19, 30]. Damit wir aber festiglich glaubten, daß wir in diesen gnadenbund gehören, nam der herr Jesus in seinem letzten abendmal das brodt, dancket, brachs, gabs seinen jüngern und sprach: Nemet hin und esset, das ist mein leib, der für euch gegeben wirdt, das thut zu meiner gedechtnuß. Desselbengleichen nach dem abendmal nam er den kelch, saget danck und sprach: Nemet hin und trincket alle darauß, dieser kelch ist das neu testament in meinem blut, daß für euch und für viel vergossen wirdt zu vergebung der sünden. Solchs thut, so oft irs trincket, zu meiner gedechtnuß. Das ist, so oft ir von diesem brodt esset und von diesem kelch trincket, solt ir dardurch als durch ein gwisses gedechtnuß und pfand erinnert und versichert werden, diser meiner hertzlichen lieb und treu gegen euch, daß ich für euch, die ir sonst des ewigen todts hettet müssen sterben, meinen leib am stamm des creutzes in den todt gebe und mein blut vergiesse und euer hungerige und dürstige seelen mit demselben meinem gecreutzigten leib und vergossenem blut zum ewigen leben speise und trencke, so gwiß als einem jeden dises brodt für seinen augen gebrochen und dieser kelch im gegeben wirdt und ihr dieselben zu meiner gedechtnuß mit euerm mund esset und trincket. Auß dieser einsatzung des heiligen abendmals unsers herrn Jesu Christi sehen wir, daß er unsern glauben und vertrauen auf sein volkommen opfer, einmal am creutz geschehen, als auf den einigen grund und fundament unser seligkeyt weiset, da er unsern hungerigen und durstigen seelen zur waren speiß und tranck des ewigen lebens worden ist. Denn durch seinen todt hat er die ursach unsers ewigen hungers und kommers, nemlich die sünd, hinweggenommen und uns den lebendigmachenden geist erworben, auf daß wir durch denselben geist, der in Christo als dem haupt und in uns als seinen gliedern wohnet, ware gemeinschaft mit ihm hetten und aller seiner güter, ewigen lebens, gerechtigkeyt und herrligkeyt theilhaftigkeit würden. Darnach, daß wir auch durch denselben geist undereinander als glieder eines leibs in warer brüderlicher lieb verbunden würden, wie der heilig apostel spricht: Ein brod ist es, so seind wir viel ein leib, dieweil wir alle eines brodts teilhaftig seind [I.Kor. 10, 17]. Denn wie aus vielen körnlein ein meel gemahlen und ein brodt gebacken wirdt und aus vielen börlein zusammengekeltert ein wein und tranck fleust und sich ineinander menget, also sollen wir alle, so durch waren glauben Christo eingeleibt sein, durch brüderliche lieb umb Christi, unsers lieben heilands, willen, der uns zuvor so hoch geliebet hat, allsamen ein leib sein und solches nit allein mit worten, sonder mit der that gegeneinander beweisen. Das helf uns der allmechtige, barmhertzige Gott und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi durch seinen heiligen geist, Amen.

Ye beloved in the Lord Jesus Christ, hear the words of the institution of the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, which the holy apostle Paul describeth to us in the first epistle to the Corinthians, in the eleventh chapter: I have received of the Lord that which I delivered unto you. For the Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took bread, gave thanks, brake it and said: Take, eat, this is my body, which is broken for you. This do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also the cup after the supper, and said: This cup is the new testament in my blood. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. For as often as ye eat this bread and drink this cup, ye shall show the Lord's death till he come. Whosoever now shall eat this bread unworthily or drink of the cup of the Lord, he is guilty of the body and blood of the Lord. But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily eateth and drinketh judgment to himself, in that he discerneth not the Lord's body. That we may now keep the Lord's Supper to our comfort, it is needful for us above all things, first, that we rightly examine ourselves beforehand; secondly, that we direct it to that end for which the Lord Christ ordained it, namely to his remembrance. The true examination of ourselves standeth in these three parts. First, let every one consider by himself his sin and curse, that he may be displeased with himself and humble himself before God, forasmuch as the wrath of God against sin is so great that, rather than let it go unpunished, he hath punished it in his dear Son Jesus Christ with the bitter and shameful death of the cross. Secondly, let every one search his heart whether he also believe this sure promise of God, that all his sins are forgiven him only for the sake of the passion and death of Jesus Christ, and that the perfect righteousness of Christ is imputed and given him as his own, as if he himself in his own person had paid for all his sins and fulfilled all righteousness. Thirdly, let every one search his conscience whether he be also minded henceforth to show himself thankful to God the Lord with his whole life and to walk uprightly before the face of God; whether he also renounce from the heart, without all hypocrisy, all enmity, envy and hatred, and have an earnest purpose hereafter to live in true love and unity with his neighbour. They now that are so minded, them God will surely receive into grace and acknowledge for worthy table-companions of his Son Jesus Christ. But on the other hand, they that feel not this witness in their heart eat and drink judgment to themselves. Therefore we also, according to the command of Christ and of the apostle Paul, warn away from the table of the Lord all that know themselves laden with the following vices, and declare unto them that they have no part in the kingdom of Christ: as are all idolaters; all that call upon departed saints, angels or other creatures, that worship images; all sorcerers and

soothsayers, that bless cattle and people and other things, and they that give credence to such blessing; all despisers of God and of his word and of the holy sacraments; all blasphemers; all that seek to make division and mutiny in the Church and in the temporal government; all perjurers; all that are disobedient to their parents and rulers; all manslayers, brawlers, quarrellers, that live in envy and hatred against their neighbour; all adulterers, whoremongers, drunkards, thieves, usurers, robbers, gamblers, covetous, and all they that lead an offensive life. All these, so long as they persevere in such vices, shall take heed and abstain from this meat, which Christ hath ordained for his faithful alone, lest their judgment and damnation be the heavier. But this is not set before us, dear Christians, to make the broken hearts of the faithful faint-hearted, as though none might go to the Supper of the Lord but they that were without all sin. For we come not to this Supper to bear witness thereby that we are perfect and righteous in ourselves, but on the contrary, because we seek our life outside ourselves in Jesus Christ, we confess that we lie in the midst of death. Therefore, although we yet find much infirmity and misery in us, as namely that we have not a perfect faith, that we do not give ourselves to serve God with such zeal as we are bound to do, but have daily to strive with the weakness of our faith and the evil lusts of our flesh; nevertheless, since by the grace of the Holy Ghost such infirmities are grievous to us from the heart, and we heartily desire to resist our unbelief and to live according to all the commandments of God, we shall be sure and certain that no sin nor infirmity which yet remaineth in us against our will can hinder God from receiving us into grace and so making us worthy partakers of this heavenly meat and drink. Secondly, let us now also consider to what end the Lord hath instituted his Supper for us, namely that we do it in remembrance of him. And we shall remember him herein thus: first, that we wholly trust in our heart that our Lord Jesus Christ, according to the promises which were made to the patriarchs from the beginning, was sent by the Father into this world, took our flesh and blood upon him, bore for us the wrath of God, under which we should have sunk for ever, from the beginning of his incarnation to the end of his life on earth, and fulfilled for us all obedience to the divine law and righteousness; chiefly when the burden of our sins and of the wrath of God pressed out from him the bloody sweat in the garden; when he was bound, that he might loose us; then suffered countless reproach, that we might never be put to shame; was condemned to death innocent, that we might be acquitted before the judgment seat of God; yea, let his blessed body be nailed to the cross, that he might nail thereto the handwriting of our sins, and so took the curse upon himself from us, that he might fill us with his blessing; and humbled himself to the very deepest shame and hellish anguish of body and soul on the tree of the cross, when he cried with a loud voice: My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me, that we might be taken to God and never be forsaken of him; and finally by his death and shedding of blood sealed the new and everlasting testament, the covenant of grace and reconciliation, as he said: It is finished. But that we might firmly believe that we belong to this covenant of grace, the Lord Jesus in his last Supper took the bread, gave thanks, brake it, gave it to his disciples and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. Likewise after the supper he took the cup, gave thanks and said: Take and drink ye all of it; this cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. That is, as oft as ye eat of this bread and drink of this cup, ye shall thereby, as by a sure memorial and pledge, be reminded and assured of this my hearty love and faithfulness toward you: that for you, who must otherwise have died the eternal death, I give my body unto death on the tree of the cross and shed my blood, and feed and give drink to your hungry and thirsty souls with the same my crucified body and shed blood unto eternal life, as surely as this bread is broken before the eyes of every one and this cup is given him, and ye eat and drink them with your mouth in remembrance of me. From this institution of the holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ we see that he directeth our faith and trust to his perfect sacrifice, once made on the cross, as to the only ground and foundation of our salvation, in that he is become the true meat and drink of eternal life to our hungry and thirsty souls. For by his death he hath taken away the cause of our eternal hunger and misery, namely sin, and hath obtained for us the quickening Spirit, that through the same Spirit, which dwelleth in Christ as the head and in us as his members, we might have true fellowship with him and become partakers of all his goods, of eternal life, righteousness and glory. Moreover, that through the same Spirit we might also be bound together one with another, as members of one body, in true brotherly love, as the holy apostle saith: It is one bread, so are we, being many, one body, forasmuch as we are all partakers of one bread. For as out of many grains one meal is ground and one bread baked, and out of many grapes pressed together one wine and drink floweth and is mingled together, so shall we all, that are incorporated into Christ by true faith, through brotherly love, for the sake of Christ our dear Saviour, who first loved us so highly, be all together one body, and show the same one toward another not only with words but in deed. The almighty, merciful God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ help us thereto through his Holy Ghost, Amen.

**What follows.** A prayer for the right use of the Supper ("Barmhertziger Gott und vater, wir bitten dich, daß du in diesem abendmal … durch deinen heiligen geist in unsern hertzen wöllest wircken …"), the Our Father and the Apostles' Creed, and then the call to lift up the heart: "so laßt uns mit unsern hertzen nicht an dem eusserlichen brodt und wein haften, sonder unsere hertzen und glauben uber sich in den himel erheben, da Christus Jesus ist" (let us not cleave with our hearts to the outward

bread and wine, but lift up our hearts and faith on high into heaven, where Christ Jesus is; Sehling 14, p. 386). It is the Reformed form of the *Sursum corda*.

**The witnesses.**

| Order | Sehling | Form and significant variants |
|---|---|---|
| Moers, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 (Reformed) | 22, pp. 197–199 | Lower Rhine recension (below); the manuscript is supplemented by the editor from the Palatinate print where it has gaps |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619 (Reformed) | 22, pp. 271–274 | Lower Rhine recension; drops "und, die solchen segen glauben geben" from the list of the excluded |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed) | 10, pp. 651–653 | Verbatim; the editor: the whole chapter, prayers included, "stammt wörtlich aus der kurpfälzischen kirchenordnung von 1563" (comes word for word from the Palatinate order of 1563) |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 (later edition) (Reformed) | 14, p. 384, apparatus | Allows the passage marked off in the margin to be left out "nach gelegenheit der kalten winterszeit oder sonst in nothfällen" (as the cold of winter or other need requireth) |

**The Lower Rhine recension.** Moers and Bentheim (both Reformed) share a set of changes:

- **A new transition after the Pauline text**, which recalls the opening of Micron's exhortation (Reformed) ("Ihr habt, lieben brüder, auß dieser lehre des heiligen apostels Pauli gehöret, wer der einsetzer des nachtmals sey …", Sehling 7/1, p. 631). **Moers, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 197):

> Auß dieser lehr deß heiligen apostels Pauli hört ihr, lieben christen, daß unnser herr unnd heilandt Jesus Christus daß heiligh nachtmahl hab eingesezt und gehalten mit seinen jungern unnd daß er unns also dasselb zu halten befohlen habe.

From this teaching of the holy apostle Paul ye hear, dear Christians, that our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ instituted and kept the holy Supper with his disciples, and that he hath commanded us so to keep the same.

- **The first point of the examination expanded:** "seine sünde, die er wider Gott und sein heiliges gesetz und wider seinen nechsten gethan hat, und folgends die vermaledeiung und gerechten zorn Gottes wider die sünde" (his sin which he hath done against God and his holy law and against his neighbour, and then the curse and righteous wrath of God against sin).
- **The second point:** "alle seine sünden, sowol angeborne als thätliche" (all his sins, original as well as actual), forgiven "auß gnaden" (of grace).
- **The third point:** thankfulness "für seine unaussprechliche gnade und barmherzigkeit und sonderlich für die gnädige vergebung aller unser sünden" (for his unspeakable grace and mercy, and especially for the gracious forgiveness of all our sins), "die zeit seines lebens" (all the time of his life); "alle feindschaft, haß, neid".
- **The excluded:** those that persevere in the vices "und darinne noch fortzufahren fürhabens seindt" (and purpose to continue therein).
- **The Spirit:** "uns den lebendigmachenden geist durch seine vorbitt erlangt" (hath obtained for us the quickening Spirit by his intercession) for "erworben" (merited).
- **Moers** reads "traubenkörnlein" (grape-berries) for "börlein".

#### 3.5.11 The Pfalz-Veldenz family, 1574

**The archetype.** The Pfalz-Veldenz order has an exhortation of its own, read by the pastor after the Sanctus ("Esaja, dem Propheten, das geschach") and before the communion. It closes with a call to confession and prayer that leads into the Mecklenburg prayer, turned into the plural (§3.5.9). **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, pp. 500–501):

> Ir geliebten in dem herrn Christo. Euch als Christen ist auß Gottes wortt und täglicher erfarung wol bewust, das wir alle sampt in sünden empfangen und geborn, auch noch täglichen immerdar sündigen und Gottes gebott ubertretten unnd

> das wir dardurch den schweren zorn Gottes und ewiger verdamnus unnderworffen sein. Nun hat uns auß diser so grossen noth anders nit khönnen geholffen werden dann allein durch den bittern unnd aller heiligsten todt und fröhliche ufferstehung unnsers herrn und heilandts Jesu Christi, des ewigen und einigen Sohns Gottes. Diser hat auß unermesslicher liebe unnd erbarmnus den schweren last unnserer sünden uff sich geladen, an das Creutz gehefftet und in die Erde begraben und also durch vergiessung seines thewren, unschuldigen bluts die sünde bezahlet und das menschlich geschlecht von sünden und ewiger verdamnus erlöset. Solch sein thewers verdienst unnd alles, was er damit erlangt und erworben hat, gibt und schenckhet er uns armen sündern umbsonnst, aus lautter gnadt und Barmhertzigkheit, wir seind sein nit werth, könnens auch nit verdhienen noch etwas darzuthun, allein sollen wir uns dessen hertzlich annehmmen, frewen unnd trösten mit festem glauben unnd gantzem vertrawen, wer das thut, der geneusset und würdt theilhafftig des verdhiensts Christi, ist von sünden undt todt gefreyet und ein Erbe des ewigen lebens. Dieweil es aber menschlicher Natur, bevorab do der Mensch seine sünde nicht erkennet und fühlet, sehr schwer ist, dises warhafftig zuglauben, das der eingeborne Sohn Gottes für uns arme sünder solchen schmählichen, bittern Todt gelitten habe und das der himmelische Vatter allein umb desselbigen willen, auß lautter gnaden und Barmhertzigkheit unns alle sünden vergeben und das ewige leben schenckhen wölle, so hat unnser getrewer hailanndt Christus Jesus uns solche grosse gnadt nitt allein in seinem heiligen wort reichlich versprochen und zugesagt, sonder auch mitt eusserlichen, sichtbarn zaichen becrefftiget und versigelt und sonderlich hierzu dises heilig Sacrament seines leibs und bluts eingesetzt, das dardurch unnser schwache glaub gesterckt, unnsere verzagte gewissen getröstet und seiner verheissenen gnaden gentzlich versichert werden sollen. Sintemahl er selbs hie zugegen ist und in der nüessung diser eusserlichen, sichtbarn dingen, brodts und weins, uns seinen warhafftigen leib und blut zur speiß und tranckh gibt als gewisse Pfanndt und sigell, uns damitt zuversichern, das er so gewiß und warhafftig sein heiligen leib für uns hingegeben und sein unschuldiges blutt für unnsere Sünde vergossen habe und uns die Sünde gewißlich umb seines leidens uns sterbens willen vergeben werden, das er auch bey uns sein, in uns wohnen und würckhen und uns als lebendige glider seines leibs entlich vom dodt ufferweckhen und das ewig leben geben wölle. Solchen herrlichen, süessen trost haben wir in disem seinem heiligen Abendtmahl. Derohalben, so offt wir fühlen, das wir im glauben schwach unnd kleinmüettig, in dem leben sündig und gebrechlich sein, sollen wir uns zu disem tröstlichen, himmelischen Tisch und Abendtmahl verfüegen, uff das wir unnsere Versöhnung mit Gott und der vergebung unnserer sünden durch den Todt Christi vergewisset unnd also im glauben an den herrn Christum gesterckhet und getröstet werden. Damit wir aber diß Sacrament recht würdiglich zu unnserm trost und der Seelen seeligkheit brauchen und nüessen mögen, so müessen wir uns zuvor nach der lehr des hailigen apostels Pauli selbs prüefen. Unnd erstlich unsere Sünde mit hertzlichem schmertzen, rew und laidt vor Gott erkhennen und bekhennen. Darnach zum andern vhestiglich glauben, das uns allein auß lautter gnaden, umb des herrn Jesu Christi willen, die sünden vergeben werden. Unnd letstlich warhafftigen fürsatz haben, von sünden abzustehen, unnser leben mit Gottes hülff zubessern und in Christlicher lieb hinfürth zuwandlen. Dann es will ja unnser herr Gott nit des sünders Todt und verderben, darbey aber erfordert er auch warhafftige bekherung, wie in dem thewren aidt, so er durch den Propheten geschworen, gemeldet würdt: So wahr ich lebe (spricht Gott), will ich nit, das der sünder sterbe, sondern das er bekheret werde und das leben habe. Derohalben, meine geliebten, dieweil unnser lieber herr Gott ein gefallens hat an den sündern, die sich vor ime demüetigen und zu ime bekheren, und auch der herr Christus zu diser seiner Malzeitt solche gäste ladet und fordert, die do hungert und dürstet nach der gerechtigkeitt, so last auch unns unnsere hertzen mit Ernst zu Gott erheben, ime unnser Elenndt, gebrechlich und sündlich leben von hertzen clagen und bekhennen unnd im Namen seines aller liebsten sohns, unnsers einigen Erlösers Jesu Christi, umb verzeyhung aller unnserer sünden und missethat bitten, ihm auch für seine herrliche gnaden und wolthaten, so er uns und der gantzen Christenheit in dem selben seinem geliebten sohn Jesu Christo erzeigt, hertzlich danncknen unnd dann ferrner umb sterckhung des glaubens, besserung unnsers sündtlichen lebens und alle andere Notturfft der gantzen Christenheit bitten, sprecht derohalben mit mir von gantzem hertzen:

Ye beloved in the Lord Christ. It is well known to you as Christians, out of God's word and daily experience, that we were all together conceived and born in sins, and also still sin daily and continually and transgress God's commandments, and that we are thereby subject to the heavy wrath of God and to eternal damnation. Now out of so great a need we could be helped in no other way than only by the bitter and most holy death and joyful resurrection of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, the eternal and only Son of God. He out of immeasurable love and compassion hath laden the heavy burden of our sins upon himself, fastened it to the cross and buried it in the earth, and so by the shedding of his precious, innocent blood hath paid for sin and redeemed mankind from sins and eternal damnation. This his precious merit, and all that he hath obtained and gained thereby, he giveth and bestoweth on us poor sinners freely, out of pure grace and mercy; we are not worthy of it, neither can we merit it nor add anything thereto; only we should heartily take it to ourselves, rejoice and comfort ourselves with firm faith and whole trust. Whoso doeth that, he enjoyeth and is made partaker of the merit of Christ, is set free from sins and death, and is an heir

of eternal life. But forasmuch as it is very hard for human nature, especially when a man knoweth not and feeleth not his sin, truly to believe this, that the only-begotten Son of God suffered such a shameful, bitter death for us poor sinners, and that the heavenly Father will forgive us all sins and give us eternal life only for his sake, out of pure grace and mercy, therefore our faithful Saviour Christ Jesus hath not only richly promised and pledged us such great grace in his holy word, but also confirmed and sealed it with outward, visible signs, and especially instituted for this end this holy Sacrament of his body and blood, that thereby our weak faith may be strengthened, our fainthearted consciences comforted, and wholly assured of his promised grace. Since he himself is here present, and in the eating of these outward, visible things, bread and wine, giveth us his true body and blood for meat and drink, as sure pledges and seals, to assure us thereby that he hath as surely and truly given his holy body for us and shed his innocent blood for our sins, and that our sins are surely forgiven us for the sake of his passion and death; that he also will be with us, dwell and work in us, and as living members of his body at last raise us from death and give us eternal life. Such glorious, sweet comfort have we in this his holy Supper. Therefore, as oft as we feel that we are weak and fainthearted in faith, sinful and frail in life, we shall betake ourselves to this comfortable, heavenly table and Supper, that we may be made sure of our reconciliation with God and of the forgiveness of our sins through the death of Christ, and so be strengthened and comforted in faith in the Lord Christ. But that we may use and enjoy this Sacrament rightly and worthily, to our comfort and the salvation of our souls, we must first examine ourselves according to the teaching of the holy apostle Paul: and first acknowledge and confess our sins before God with hearty pain, repentance and sorrow; then secondly firmly believe that our sins are forgiven us only of pure grace for the Lord Jesus Christ's sake; and lastly have a true purpose to forsake sins, to amend our life with God's help, and henceforth to walk in Christian love. For our Lord God will not the death and destruction of the sinner; but therewith he requireth also true conversion, as is declared in the precious oath which he hath sworn by the prophet: As I live (saith God), I will not that the sinner die, but that he be converted and have life. Therefore, my beloved, forasmuch as our dear Lord God hath pleasure in sinners that humble themselves before him and turn to him, and the Lord Christ also inviteth and biddeth to this his meal such guests as hunger and thirst after righteousness, let us also lift up our hearts to God with earnestness, heartily lament and confess to him our misery and our frail and sinful life, and in the name of his dearest Son, our only Redeemer Jesus Christ, pray for the pardon of all our sins and misdeeds; heartily thank him also for his glorious graces and benefits which he hath shown to us and to all Christendom in the same his beloved Son Jesus Christ; and then further pray for the strengthening of faith, the amendment of our sinful life, and all other need of all Christendom. Say therefore with me from your whole heart:

**What follows.** "Beicht und gemeine gebett bey der Communion" (confession and common prayer at the communion): the Mecklenburg prayer in the plural, "Allmechtiger, barmhertziger Gott, ewiger und einiger Vatter unnsers herrn Jesu Christi … Wir bekhennen ja, herr, das wir vil sünde an uns haben, seind von Natur sündhafft und unrein …" (Sehling 18, p. 501). The exhortation itself draws on Mecklenburg 1552 for the oath of Ezekiel 33:11 and the call to conversion.

**The witness.** Lützelstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1605 (Sehling 18, pp. 603–604) copies the text; the editor marks the section "aus KO Pfalz-Veldenz". It drops "warhafftig" (truly to believe), "reichlich" (richly promised) and "und fordert" (and biddeth), and ends "sprecht derohalben demütiglich mit mir" (say therefore humbly with me).

#### 3.5.12 The Basel family: Memmingen 1528 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560

**The archetype.** The Memmingen order of 1528 (Moderate Reformed) has an exhortation read *after* communion. Sehling's editor notes that it is not in the Zürich order, which Memmingen otherwise follows. Neckarbischofsheim 1560 has the same text, which its editor traces to Oecolampadius's Basel order, *Form und gstalt* (Basel 1526, Reformed). **Memmingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 245):

> Nach der nießung, so jederman geessen und trunken hat, folget nachgeende vermanung. Lieben brüder! Ir habt gehört die unaussprechlich barmherzigkait Gottes. Der himlisch Vater hat sein aingebornen Sun für uns in den schmehlichsten tod gegeben. Der hirt ist gestorben für die schäflin. Der unschuldig hat gelitten für den sünder, das haupt für die gelider. Der oberst priester hat sich […] selbest zuo ainem brinnenden opfer aus unseglicher lieb dem Vater für uns aufgeopfert und mit seinem bluot unser verbindnus mit Got dem Vater genuogsam versichert und versiegelt. Darumb laßt uns die guottaten in ewiger, frischer gedechtnus halten! Sein bluot berür unser herz! Im sei lob in ewigkait! Nun wöllen wir hinfüran nit unser sein, sondern des Herren knecht und diener seiner knecht. Nun wöllen wir Christo und nit uns leben und begeren, also ime eingeleibt sein als die gelider, die wir durch sein bluot erlöst und von sünden gerainiget seind.

After the eating, when every one hath eaten and drunk, followeth the exhortation hereafter following. Dear brethren! Ye have heard the unspeakable mercy of God. The heavenly Father hath given his only-begotten Son for us into the most shameful

death. The shepherd hath died for the sheep. The innocent hath suffered for the sinner, the head for the members. The high priest hath offered himself up for us to the Father as a burning sacrifice, out of unspeakable love, and with his blood hath sufficiently assured and sealed our covenant with God the Father. Therefore let us keep the benefits in everlasting, fresh remembrance! His blood touch our heart! To him be praise for evermore! Now henceforth we will not be our own, but the Lord's servants and the servants of his servants. Now we will live to Christ and not to ourselves, and desire so to be incorporated into him as the members that are redeemed by his blood and cleansed from sins.

**What follows at Memmingen.** The deacons say Ps 113 in alternation ("Lobet, ir diener den Herren!"), and the leader then gives the second exhortation, which comes from Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; §3.5.13), ending with the Ten Commandments and the dismissal "Nun gond hin im frid Gottes" (Now go in the peace of God).

**The witness.** Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560 (Sehling 16, pp. 682–683). Its form:

- **Placement.** The pastor reads it at the altar *before* communion, as "die Comunicanten vermanung oder erinerung von dem leiden und Sterben Jesu Christi sampt angehenckhter vermahnung" (the communicants' exhortation or reminder of the passion and death of Jesus Christ, with an appended exhortation).
- **The opening.** Before it stands Isaiah 53, introduced: "Geliebten Freund und userwelte kinder gottes. Dieweil in Empfahung des h[eiligen] Nachtmals … das fürnembste hauptstuckh … ist, zu bedenkchen mit hertzlicher danckhsagung sein bitter leiden und Sterben, so heret und bedenckht, wie der h[eilige] prophet Esaja solches vor langer zeit im gaist für gesehen hat" (Beloved friends and chosen children of God, forasmuch as in the receiving of the holy Supper the chief point and the whole matter is to consider with hearty thanksgiving his bitter passion and death, hear and consider how the holy prophet Isaiah foresaw it in the spirit long ago).
- **The common text** follows with "All hie heret ir offentlich, geliebten kinder gottes" (Here ye hear openly, beloved children of God) for "Ir habt gehört"; "Sein blut besprenge und beruhre unsere hertzen" (His blood sprinkle and touch our hearts; Heb 10:22); "Im sey lob, ehr und preis in ewigkait"; "darzu knecht und diner seiner knecht".
- **An addition on the Supper**, leading to the Words of Institution. **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 683):

> Darumb wir auch mit danckhsagung eingedenckh seind der guthaten seines leibs und Bluts, welche er uns in Crafft des glaubens an sein wort warhafftigklich gibt zu genießen, fürgebildet in leiblicher Speis und tranckh des gehayligten Brots und weins seines Abentmals, so er uns zu gedechtnis seines bittern leiden und Sterben selbs eingesetzt und verordnet hat zu halten.

Wherefore we also are mindful with thanksgiving of the benefits of his body and blood, which he truly giveth us to enjoy in the power of faith in his word, figured in the bodily meat and drink of the hallowed bread and wine of his Supper, which he himself instituted and ordained us to keep in remembrance of his bitter passion and death.

### 3.5.13 The Strasbourg family, 1525

**The archetype.** The early Strasbourg agendas (Moderate Reformed) leave the exhortation to the pastor, "auff den inhalt des gepets und gemeinlich noch der getonen predig materien" (on the content of the prayer and generally according to the matter of the sermon preached), and print one as an example. It was given at St. Peter the Younger, Wolfgang Capito's church, on Reminiscere Sunday, 12 March 1525, after a sermon on 1 Cor 1 (the word of the cross) and John 8 (Christ the light of the world). It is read after the Our Father and leads into the Words of Institution. **Strasbourg, *Die frühen Agenden*, 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 158–159):

> Lieben brüder und schwester, ir wöllen ein jedes bey im bedencken, mit was hertzlicher begird der herr Jesus sein leyden für uns gethon hat und wie groß verlangen er gehebt, das osterlamb mitt seinen jüngern zu essen, ee er litte, Und wie er befolhen hat, das man diese sein gedechtniß, so offt man sein nachtmal haltet, haben sol, Wie die alten christen in iren versamlungen beynach gehalten haben und wir am Sontag etlicher maß erzeygen, In dem das etlich auß eüch mit mir essen. Unnd aber hoff ich, ir alle in steiffem glauben bedencken unnd eben als wol fruchtbarlich im geyst essen, als die, so er zuher geen, Dann uns das eüsserlich essen würd vil unordenung und mühe bringen, wo jederman allemal auch leyplich essen wolt, Dann wir in allen dingen nitt eüsserlich thaten des herren, sonder das hauptstuck innerlichen treyben sollen, welchs hie ist die gedechtniß unser erlösung, so bey eüch umstendern allen woll sein mag. Darumb ermane ich eüch, das ir eüch lassen das wort des creützs fohen, […] welichs eüch, so selig werden, die krafft Gottes ist, wie der verdamten weltt ein thorheit und den frummen schein heylgen ein ergernüß. Nemen an Christum, das liecht der welt,

> und wandeln fürter nit mer in der finsternüß, das ist, nach der art blut und fleischs, welches voller zanck, hader und zwitracht ist. Dann wo ir eüch annemen und mit ewer niessung oder gegenwertikeit falschlich fürgeben den glauben an Christum und die liebe gegen ewrens nechsten und dannocht in verdruß stünden gegen ewren mitbrüdern, so wissent, das ir Gott, dem heylgen geist, liegen, das ir gleißner sein und das ir bey des herrn nachtmal unwirdiglich sein oder selbs niessen eüch zum urteyl unnd zur verdamnüß. Bitten also Got, das er uns den verborgnen Adam in uns entdecke und sein heyl erzeyge, so er durch Christum Jesum gemacht hat.

Dear brothers and sisters, ye will every one consider with himself with what hearty desire the Lord Jesus did his suffering for us, and how great longing he had to eat the passover lamb with his disciples before he suffered; and how he commanded that this his remembrance should be had as oft as his Supper is kept, as the old Christians nearly did in their assemblies, and as we in some measure show on the Sunday, in that some of you eat with me. And yet I hope that ye all consider it in firm faith, and eat as fruitfully in the spirit as they that come forward; for the outward eating would bring us much disorder and trouble if every one would also eat bodily every time; for in all things we should not practise the outward deeds of the Lord, but the chief part inwardly, which here is the remembrance of our redemption, which may well be with all of you that stand about. Therefore I exhort you that ye let yourselves be taken by the word of the cross, which to you that are saved is the power of God, as to the damned world it is foolishness and to the pious hypocrites an offence. Receive Christ, the light of the world, and walk no more henceforth in darkness, that is, after the manner of flesh and blood, which is full of strife, quarrelling and discord. For if ye take upon you, and by your eating or presence falsely pretend, faith in Christ and love toward your neighbour, and yet stood in grudge against your brethren, know that ye lie to God the Holy Ghost, that ye are hypocrites, and that ye are at the Lord's Supper unworthily, or eat to yourselves judgment and damnation. Let us pray God, therefore, that he would uncover to us the hidden Adam in us, and show his salvation, which he hath wrought through Christ Jesus.

**Note.** The exhortation assumes that only some will commune ("In dem das etlich auß eüch mit mir essen"), and that the rest "im geyst essen" (eat in the spirit). It then turns to the invitation: "Ir, so mit mir wöllen des herren nachtmal entpfahen und so sich angezeygt haben, kommen nun her" (Ye that will receive the Lord's Supper with me, and have announced yourselves, come now hither; Sehling 20/1, p. 159).

**The witness.** Memmingen 1528 (Moderate Reformed) takes the second half, from "das ir euch lasset das wort des kreuz fahen", as the exhortation of the leader after Ps 113 and after communion (Sehling 12, pp. 245–246). It reads "nach art der bösen vergiften natur, bluets und flaischs" (after the manner of the evil, poisoned nature of blood and flesh), turns the warning into the past ("des Herren nachtmal unwirdig empfangen hetten", would have received the Lord's Supper unworthily), and ends with a prayer that God lead us "aus uns selbs und allen creaturen zuo seinem eingebornen Sun" (out of ourselves and all creatures to his only-begotten Son), followed by the Ten Commandments.

### 3.5.14 Exhortations outside the families

The exhortations below belong to none of the families in §3.5.3–3.5.13. Four are printed in full; the rest are summarized.

#### 3.5.14.1 Kantz 1522 and the Bremen Mass 1525

Kantz's Nördlingen Mass of 1522 leaves the exhortation free: "ein ermanung … von dem sacrament oder sunst etwas tröstlichs us dem heiligen evangelio … wie im der Geist Gottes eingibt" (an exhortation of the Sacrament, or else something comforting out of the holy Gospel, as the Spirit of God giveth him). It then gives only a short address to the bystanders, "Allerliebsten in Christo! Uf das ir mit frölichem, begirigem herzen entpfahent …", which leads at once into the absolution. That address and absolution are printed in Chapter 7 §7.2.1, and summarized in §3.3.5 here.

The Low German *Evangelische Misse* printed at Bremen in 1525 has the same rubric and a translation of the same address. **Bremen, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 405):

> Tom irsten scal de prester ofte eyn ander, darto gekaren, eyne vormaninge don van den Sacramente ofte anders ichtes wat trostelijkes uthe den hilgen Evangelio Unde seggen, dat eme de geist gades ingift. Darumme scal he de bisitters myt dussen ofte dus geliken worden vormanen: Alderlevesten in Christo, Uppe dat gy myt vroliken unde begerliken herten entfangen mogen den kosteliken schat unde dat testamente des vlesches unde blodes Christi Jesu, unses salichmakers, So othomodiget iuwe herten jegen Got unde kennet eme iuwe sunde unde gebreken myt herteliker begerten, trachtende na syner gotliken genade unde hulpe. So wil ick iuw nu lesen de absolucien

First shall the priest, or another chosen thereto, make an exhortation of the Sacrament, or else somewhat comforting out of the holy Gospel, and say what the Spirit of God giveth him. Therefore shall he exhort the bystanders with these or the like words: Dearest in Christ, that ye may receive with joyful and desirous hearts the precious treasure and the testament of the flesh and blood of Christ Jesus, our Saviour, humble your hearts before God and confess to him your sins and failings with hearty desire, striving after his godly grace and help. So will I now read you the absolution.

**The differences.** Bremen has "den kosteliken schat unde dat testamente des vlesches unde blodes" (the precious treasure and the testament of the flesh and blood) for Kantz's "den zarten fronleichnam und rosenfarbes blut" (the tender body and rose-coloured blood). It drops "euer erwölter priester" (your chosen priest), and it heads the priest's request for prayer "Bicht des presters" (the priest's confession). The absolution keeps Kantz's indicative form (§3.4.4).

#### 3.5.14.2 Augsburg, St. Anna, 1530

The order of the Supper (Moderate Reformed) "wie die gehalten worden ist, durch die diener des ewangelions zu sant Anna" (as it was kept by the ministers of the Gospel at St. Anna's) prints two exhortations. The first, the longer, is a sermon on 1 Cor 11:28 in three heads: why Christ died, the love of God in his death, and the example of love it leaves. **Augsburg, *Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal*, 1530** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, pp. 40–41):

> Ir geliebten! Sant Paulus ermant uns 1. Corinth. am 11. [28], wir sollen uns vor probieren und aldann zu Gottes tisch geen. Darumb soll eur lieb zum ersten sehen, warinen die prob stande, damit man nit das gerucht esse und trink. So muessen wir nun mit ernst bedenken, was man hie tue, was da sei und was hie gesucht soll werden. Man soll zum ersten ansehen, was Christus getan hab und uns zu tun bevolhen, nemblich: wir sollen sein gedenken, sein hailsamen tod verkünden, hinz er kompt. Hie ist nit ain bauchmal, sonder ain speis und trank zu ainem neuen leben, darinnen uns Christus will speisen mit seinem waren leib und trenken mit seinem waren plut, so hie zugegen seind umb seines worts willen, wie er seine jünger gspeiset und trenket im ersten abentmal, durch wölichen leib und sein plut er uns am creuz mit seinem tod vom ewigen tod erkauft, ablaß der sünd erworben und zwischen Got dem Vater und uns den gnadenbund aufgericht und bestätiget hat, das wir durch Cristum und in Cristo sollen kinder Gottes werden und Got unser Vater sein. Darumb suchen wir hie nit irdisch, zergenklich ding, sonder ewigs. Wir seien krank und suchen erznei des lebens. Wir seien hungerig und durstig und suchen das lebentig prot, das von himel kompt: Jesum Cristum, den prunnen des ewigen lebens. Wer in in vertraut, wirt ersettiget und das ewig leben haben. Das vertrauen ist, das wir nit sollen zweifeln, der sun Gottes Jesus Cristus sei aus dem gnedigen willen seines und unsers himlischen Vaters für uns arme sünder gestorben und habe uns dem himlischen Vater wider versönt. Das ist der recht christlich glaub. Wer sich solichs nit zu Cristo versicht, nemlich: das er unser hailand sei, der uns von allem übel helfen will und kan (denn er ist warer Got und umb unsertwillen mensch worden), der were unglaubig und esse im selbs das gericht. Darumb sollen wir sehen, das man hie nit den leiblichen, sonder den gaistlichen hunger und durst bießen soll. So bevilcht uns nun Cristus, wir sollen das nachtmal halten im zur gedechtnus, und Paulus sagt, wir sollen den tod des Herren verkinden, bis er kompt. Do müssen wir nun drei ding für uns nemen, zum ersten: ursach sehen, warumb Cristus gestorben sei; zum andern: die liebe Gottes und gnad im tod seines aingepornen Suns zu herzen nemen; zum dritten: besehen, wie uns Cristus mit sein tod nit allain erlost hat, sonder auch ain exempel hat gelassen, darbei wir lernen, was treue und liebe ain jeglicher crist seinem nebenmenschen schuldig sei. Können wir uns nun selbs recht in disen dreien stucken erinnern und finden uns darzu berait oder zum wenigisten begirig, das wir im glauben und liebe gern wollten wandeln, so besteet die prob davon sant Paulus sagt [1. Kor. 11, 28].
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> Zum ersten merkt, das Cristus ist gestorben umb unser sund willen. Es muß freilich nit ain klaine ursach sein, das Gottes Sun von himel selbs soll komen in dise welt und sich in den verschmechten tod des creuz gibt. Dabei merken wir die große und schwere unserer sünd, die nit mocht gebueßt werden, es neme si dann ain soliche unendliche person auf sich, Jesa. am 53. [4f.]. Wie grausam ist das urtail Gottes uber die sund und sunder! Wie mordlich ist der schad unsere sund, das der aingeporn allerliebst Sun Gottes soll ain vermaledeiung werden und sterben, auf das wir von dem ewigen fluch und tod erlöst wurden. Dieweil nun Cristus selbs stirbt, das er gnug tue fur uns und den Vater wider versöne, den Gaist Gottes erwerbe, dadurch wir erleucht, gerainigt und zu kindern Gottes zugerust werden, warlich so sollen wir den teuren tod Cristi, disen unermeßlichen costen, in unser herz pilden und die verdampten sund, so Cristo zum tod ain ursach was, als das hellisch gift und tod hassen, fliehen und uns in ain bußfertigs leben schicken, Da gee ain jeder in sich selbs, ob in reu, das er so oft und manigfaltig wider Got gesundet hat, derhalb er ewiger verdambnus wirdig ist, und ob er beger, durch Gottes gnad von sunden entledigt zu werden und ain cristlich leben zu fueren! Wo nit, so steet er ubel.

> Zum andern bedenkent die großen gnad und liebe Gottes, der seines aingepornen Suns nit verschont hat, sonder fur uns in tod geben. So lieb hat er die welt, das er sein aingepornen in die welt sandte, das wer in in glaubt, nit verloren werd, sonder habe das ewig leben. Wo ist solich lieb je erhört worden? Da wir noch sunder waren, ist Cristus fur uns gestorben, da wir noch veind waren, seien wir Got versönt durch den tod seines Suns, zun Römern am 5. [10]. Hat euch vor als pillich eur große sund und das gerecht urtail Gottes erschreckt, so seid wider getröst! Unser sund ligen nit mer auf uns, so wir glauben, sonder auf dem unvermaßgothen lemblin Gottes. Der hat si gebueßt, den tod abgetilget, das leben widerpracht, und Cristus ist uns geschenkt vom Vater, das er sei unser weishait, gerechtigkait, hailigmachung und erlösung. Des bedürfen wir alle wol, dieweil wir in uns selbs toren, ungerecht, unhailig, arm, gefangen sunder des bösen veinds waren. Söliche große ding standen uns zu und werden unser aigen, so wir an der liebe Gottes nit zweiflen, das er sein Sun Jesum Cristum uns geschenkt hab, das wir durch in leben. Nit, das wir in zuvor haben geliebt; sonder er hat uns vor geliebt und also sein Sun gesandt, ain versöner fur unser sund 1. Johann, am 4. [9]. Da höret ir im abentmal solichs, wie Cristus hab sein leib und plut fur uns dargeben. Glauben wir disen worten, so überwinden wir sund, tod, hell, empfahen frid freud und sicherhait der gewissne, das wir dankpar werden, umb soliche guthait willig zu tun und leiden, was uns Christus auflegt. Dann dis sacrament auch eucharistia haist, das mir dabei loben und preisen söllen Gottes barmherzigkait und danksagen für sein unaussprechenliche liebe. Wo wir sein tod und darinne sein väterliche treu alltzeit gedenken, werden wir diemuetig, dankpar, wachsen im vertrauen zu Got durch Cristum werden behutsam und richten uns in ain neues leben, das denn soll und muß sein oder wir werden allain titelcristen genennt werden.
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> Zum dritten erinnert uns das nachtmal der cristlichen lieb und ainigkait; dann ist Cristus fur uns gestorben, so ists ain anzaigung, das wir an seinem leiden und sterben gemainschaft haben, und, so das haupt fur seine glider den tod hat gelitten und die höchst lieb an si gelegt, sollen wir ainer den andern auch nit verachten; dann wir seien kinder Gottes durch den verdienst Cristi under wöliche söliche große gueter ausgetailt werden und soll dise liebe Cristi uns ain exempel sein, das wir also gegenainander gesindt seien, wie Cristus gegen uns nemlich: ainer dem andern mit allem, das er ist und hat, dienen, wie am natürlichen leib ain glid dem andern. Widerwillen, nachred, haß und alle andere laster müssen abgestellt werden; denn was woltest du bei dem gemainen nachtmal des Herren tun, wann dir dein nächster nit wol bevolhen war, für den Cristus gestorben ist und der aller seiner gueter soll genießen mit allen auserwölten? Du erzaigest dich von außen als ein mitglid, das Cristum fur sein erlöser und die andern fur sein miterben und brueder erkennete, und verachtetest aber dein nächsten und gönntest im nichts guts. Wiltu kain glid sein am leib Cristi, das du andere mitglider nit magst leiden, lieben und im dienen, dich irer not annemen, als were si dem aigen, so hassest du auch das haupt, Cristum, und gehörest derhalb nit in dise gesellschaft.
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> Darumb secht auf euch selbs! Es ist nit kinderspil, zu des Herren nachtmal zu geen. Rohe, freche, unbesind leut, denen nichts daran ligt, si sunden oder nit, die pleiben nun davon. Aber gaistlich arm leut, die ain beschwerd gewissen haben, wolten gern frumb werden, wiewol si noch vast unvolkomen seind, so si aber ain mißfallen haben, ab irer aignen sund, die söllen komen und den leib und plut Jesu Cristi im nachtmal empfahen; denn Got ist gnedig den diemüetigen.

Beloved! St. Paul exhorteth us, 1 Cor 11[:28], that we should first prove ourselves and then go to God's table. Therefore shall your love first see wherein the proof standeth, that none eat and drink the judgment. So must we now consider with earnestness what is done here, what is here, and what shall be sought here. One shall first look at what Christ hath done and commanded us to do, namely: we shall remember him and show forth his saving death till he come. Here is no belly-meal, but a meat and drink unto a new life, wherein Christ will feed us with his true body and give us to drink of his true blood, which are present here for his word's sake, as he fed his disciples and gave them to drink in the first Supper; through which body and his blood he hath bought us on the cross by his death from eternal death, purchased remission of sin, and set up and confirmed the covenant of grace between God the Father and us, that through Christ and in Christ we should become children of God, and God be our Father. Therefore we seek here no earthly, perishable things, but eternal. We are sick and seek the medicine of life. We are hungry and thirsty and seek the living bread that cometh from heaven: Jesus Christ, the well of eternal life. Whoso trusteth in him shall be satisfied and have eternal life. That trust is, that we shall not doubt that the Son of God, Jesus Christ, of the gracious will of his and our heavenly Father, hath died for us poor sinners and hath reconciled us again to the heavenly Father. That is the right Christian faith. Whoso looketh not for such from Christ, namely, that he is our Saviour, who will and can help us out of all evil (for he is true God, and for our sakes is made man), he were an unbeliever and eateth judgment to himself. Therefore we shall see that here not the bodily but the spiritual hunger and thirst is to be stilled. So Christ now commandeth us that we shall keep the Supper in remembrance of him, and Paul saith that we shall show forth the Lord's death till he come. Here must we now take three things before us: first, to see the cause why Christ died; secondly, to take to heart the love and grace of God in the death of his only-begotten Son; thirdly, to consider how Christ hath not only redeemed us by his death, but also left an example, whereby we learn what faithfulness and love every Christian oweth to his fellow man. If we can now rightly

call ourselves to mind in these three points, and find ourselves ready thereto, or at the least desirous, that we would gladly walk in faith and love, then the proof standeth whereof St. Paul speaketh [1 Cor 11:28].

First, mark that Christ died for our sins' sake. It must verily be no small cause, that God's Son should himself come from heaven into this world and give himself into the despised death of the cross. Hereby we mark the greatness and heaviness of our sin, which might not be atoned unless such an infinite person took it upon himself, Isaiah 53[:4f.]. How terrible is the judgment of God upon sin and sinners! How murderous is the harm of our sin, that the only-begotten, dearest Son of God should become a curse and die, that we might be redeemed from the eternal curse and death! Since then Christ himself dieth, that he may make satisfaction for us and reconcile the Father again, and purchase the Spirit of God, whereby we are enlightened, cleansed and made ready to be children of God, verily we should form in our heart the precious death of Christ, this unmeasurable cost, and hate and flee the damned sin, which was a cause of death to Christ, as hellish poison and death, and set ourselves to a penitent life. Here let every one go into himself, whether he repent that he hath so often and so manifoldly sinned against God, wherefore he is worthy of eternal damnation, and whether he desire by God's grace to be rid of sins and to lead a Christian life! If not, he standeth ill.

Secondly, consider the great grace and love of God, who spared not his only-begotten Son, but gave him into death for us. So loved he the world, that he sent his only-begotten into the world, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have eternal life. Where hath such love ever been heard of? While we were yet sinners, Christ died for us; while we were yet enemies, we are reconciled to God by the death of his Son, Romans 5[:10]. If your great sin and the righteous judgment of God have before terrified you, as is meet, so be comforted again! Our sins lie no more upon us, if we believe, but upon the unspotted lamb of God. He hath atoned them, abolished death, brought life again; and Christ is given us of the Father, that he may be our wisdom, righteousness, sanctification and redemption. Of this we all have good need, since we in ourselves were fools, unrighteous, unholy, poor, captive sinners of the evil enemy. Such great things belong to us and become our own, if we doubt not of the love of God, that he hath given us his Son Jesus Christ, that we may live through him. Not that we loved him before; but he loved us first, and so sent his Son to be a reconciler for our sin, 1 John 4[:9]. There ye hear such things in the Supper, how Christ hath given his body and blood for us. If we believe these words, we overcome sin, death, hell, receive peace, joy and assurance of conscience, so that we become thankful, to do and to suffer willingly for such goodness what Christ layeth upon us. For this sacrament is also called *eucharistia*, that we thereby should praise and extol God's mercy and give thanks for his unspeakable love. Where we always remember his death, and therein his fatherly faithfulness, we become humble and thankful, grow in trust toward God through Christ, become heedful, and order ourselves to a new life, which then shall and must be, or we shall be called titular Christians only.

Thirdly, the Supper putteth us in mind of Christian love and unity; for if Christ hath died for us, it is a token that we have fellowship in his passion and death; and as the head hath suffered death for his members and laid the highest love upon them, we also shall not despise one another; for we are children of God through the merit of Christ, among whom such great goods are dealt out; and this love of Christ shall be an example to us, that we be so minded one toward another as Christ toward us, namely, that one serve another with all that he is and hath, as in the natural body one member serveth another. Ill will, backbiting, hatred and all other vices must be put away; for what wouldest thou do at the common Supper of the Lord, if thy neighbour were not well commended to thee, for whom Christ hath died, and who shall enjoy all his goods with all the elect? Thou showest thyself outwardly as a fellow member, who acknowledgeth Christ for his redeemer and the others for his fellow heirs and brethren, and yet thou despisest thy neighbour and grudgest him all good. If thou wilt be no member of the body of Christ, in that thou mayest not suffer the other fellow members, love them and serve them, take their need upon thee as were it thine own, then thou hatest also the head, Christ, and belongest therefore not in this fellowship.

Therefore look to yourselves! It is no child's play to go to the Lord's Supper. Rude, insolent, heedless folk, to whom it is nothing whether they sin or not, let them stay away. But spiritually poor folk, that have a burdened conscience and would fain be godly, although they be yet very imperfect, yet if they have a displeasure at their own sin, they shall come and receive the body and blood of Jesus Christ in the Supper; for God is gracious to the humble.

**The second exhortation.** After the Words of Institution the order gives a shorter text, "gepraucht … im vergangem reichstag umb kurze willen und hernach gemanklich am sontag mitsampt andern cristlichen ermanungen aus gotlicher schrift" (used at the late Diet [of 1530] for brevity's sake, and afterwards commonly on Sunday, together with other Christian exhortations out of divine scripture). It contains an indicative general absolution. **Augsburg, *Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal*, 1530** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 42):

> Ir geliebten! Ir wißt, das wir bevelch haben von Cristo, unserm Herrn und Got, das wir so predigen und die hailigen sacrament raichen söllen, vergebung der sunden predigen und alle sund vergeben an Gottes und unsers Herren Cristi stat, allen denen, so solichs begeren und daran glauben; dann also steet geschriben [Joh. 21, 23]: Wölichen ir die sund vergibt, den sollen sie vergeben sein und, welichen ir si behalt, den sollen si behalten sein. Derhalb will ich euch erstlich an stat und von wegen Gottis und unsers Herrn Cristi vergebung der sund verkunden, wie dan Cristus unser Herr fur all unser sund durch sein tod genug getan und Got versonet und gnad erworben an unser verdienst und bevolhen, von seinet wegen soliches in alle welt zu predigen und die sund zu strafen und zu vergeben. Darumb sprech ich euch alle und jedes in sonderhait, so des begeren, ledig von euren sunden und söllen euch dieselbigen aus gnaden umb Cristus willen vergeben sein aus getlichem bevelch im namen Gottes des Vaters und des Sons und des Hailigen Gaists. Der frid Gottes sei bei euch! Amen.
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> Und wöllent auch diser absolucion glauben als Gottes wort und bevelch nicht weniger dann, als höret ir Gottes stim von himel erschallen, und wisset, das ir gnad und vergebung der sund allain durch disen glauben entpfacht und das diser glaub der höchst und rechte cristlich gottesdienst ist, das ir Got die eer tuet, das ir in fur warhaftig haltet, das er sein zusagen halten werde, wölle gnedig sein, wie er verhaißen hat, wolle auch erhören und helfen, so ir hilf bei im sucht, und sollent solichen glauben üben in aller not, das ir lernent erfaren, das Got pflege warhaftiglich gnad und hilf erzaigen denen, so im und in anruefend, und diser glaub imerdar zuneme, das man als guts von Got hoffe und bei im such. Darzu ist auch das hailig sacrament eingesetzt zu gedenken, das unser Herr Cristus fur uns umb der sund willen gestorben sei und wider auferstanden, das er uns gnad, den Hailigen Gaist und ewigs leben gebe. Darumb söllet ir das hailig sacrament also entpfahen, das ir warhaftiglich glaubt, das euch hiebei gnad und vergebung der sunden angepoten werd; dann Cristus unser Herr gibt uns sein leib und sein plut, das wir ja glauben und warhaftiglich halten, er wöll bei uns sein, sein leben, sein Hailigen Gaist und sein gueter uns mittailen. Amen.

Beloved! Ye know that we have commandment from Christ, our Lord and God, that we should so preach and minister the holy sacraments, preach forgiveness of sins and forgive all sins in the stead of God and of our Lord Christ, to all them that desire such and believe it; for thus it is written [John 20:23]: Whose sins ye remit, they shall be remitted unto them, and whose ye retain, they shall be retained. Therefore will I first proclaim to you forgiveness of sins in the stead and on the behalf of God and of our Lord Christ, as Christ our Lord hath made satisfaction for all our sins by his death, and reconciled God, and purchased grace without our merit, and commanded that for his sake such be preached in all the world, and sins be rebuked and forgiven. Therefore I pronounce you all, and each one in particular that desireth it, free from your sins, and they shall be forgiven you of grace for Christ's sake, by divine commandment, in the name of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. The peace of God be with you! Amen.

And ye shall also believe this absolution as God's word and commandment, no less than if ye heard God's voice sound from heaven; and know that ye receive grace and forgiveness of sins through this faith alone, and that this faith is the highest and right Christian service of God, that ye give God the honour of holding him true, that he will keep his promise, will be gracious, as he hath promised, will also hear and help, if ye seek help of him; and ye shall exercise such faith in all need, that ye may learn by experience that God is wont truly to show grace and help to them that call upon him and in him, and that this faith may ever increase, so that one hope all good of God and seek it of him. For this also is the holy sacrament instituted, to remember that our Lord Christ died for us for sin's sake and rose again, that he might give us grace, the Holy Ghost and eternal life. Therefore ye shall so receive the holy sacrament that ye truly believe that grace and forgiveness of sins is offered you herein; for Christ our Lord giveth us his body and his blood, that we may indeed believe and truly hold that he will be with us and impart to us his life, his Holy Ghost and his goods. Amen.

**Notes.**

- **The absolution.** "Darumb sprech ich euch alle und jedes in sonderhait, so des begeren, ledig von euren sunden" is indicative, like Kantz's, and grounded in John 20:23. It belongs with the forms in §3.4.4.
- **The order of parts.** The first exhortation stands before communion; the minister then rehearses the Words of Institution ("Ee und der diener das ewangeli die gemaind communiert, wideräffert er die wort des nachtmals", before the minister communicates the congregation with the Gospel, he repeats the words of the Supper).
- **Other exhortations.** Sehling's editor, citing Fille (1895), notes that "auch einige andere solche Vermahnungen, meist von Urban Rhegius" (some other such exhortations also, mostly by Urban Rhegius) were once kept: "Sie sind aber jetzt verloren" (but they are now lost; Sehling 12, p. 40).

#### 3.5.14.3 Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565

The Buxtehude *Agende* prints, after the Latin Prefaces, a "Vormaninge vor der entfanginge des sacramentes" (exhortation before the receiving of the Sacrament). It builds on the Words of Institution, which it rehearses in full, and draws four lessons from them: what the Sacrament is, who instituted it, what it is for, and who receive it to salvation. It ends with a prayer said by all. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 124–125):

> Myne leven Christen, alle, de dut hillige aventmall unses Heren Jesu Christi fruchtbarlich to erer salicheit wyllen bedenken und holden, is hoch vannoden, datt se vor allen dingen de worde der insettinge dusses aventmals, alse desulvigen de hilligen evangelisten und Paulus beschreven hebben, vaste weten, welker also luden: Unse Here Jhesus Christus in der nacht, do he vorraden wart, nam he dat brott, dankede und brack und gaff idt synen jungeren und sprack: Nemet hen und etet, dat is myn liff, dat vor ju gegeven wert, sulcks doet to myner gedechtnisse. Dessulvengelicken nam he ock denn kelck na dem aventmale, dankede, gaff ehn und sprack: Drinket alle darut, dusse kelck is eyn nye testament in mynem blode, dat vor juw vorgaten wert tor vorgevinge der sunde. Sulckes doet, so vaken gy drynken, to myner gedechtnisse.
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> Wol dusse worde flytich betrachtet, de fynt darin allent, wat eynen framen Christen van dissen hilligen sacrament to weten nodich is, alße: Tom ersten, watt dut hillige sacramente sy, nomlick datt ware liff und dat ware blodt unses Heren Jhesu Christi, welck uns under brodt und wynn to eten und to drinken, nicht denn lycham, sunder de seele darmede to erholden, gegeven wert. Tom anderen leren disse wort, wol dutt sacramente ingesettet hefft und geordnet, nömlicken neen keyser, köninge, mynschen edder engel, sunder unße Here Jhesus Christus, de keyser aller keyser, koning aller koninge, de Her der engelen und aller creaturn, de vorloßer des mynslicken geslechtes sülvest, de einige gebaren Soene Gades, de dar is mit dem Vader und hilligen Geiste gelicker gewalt und warheit, welckes wylle und worde egentlick gescheen und nemant bedragen, wenn idt schoenn unser vornufft umbegriplich unde ummögelick [!] duchte. Tom drudden leren dusse worde, worto uns dat hillige sacramente battlich und nutte sy, nomlicken tom ersten, dat wy darmede unsen Heren Christo im gloven ingelivet und he eyns mit uns und wy eyns mit eme worden, tom ewigen levende, wo he sulven secht Jo. 6 [56 u. 54]: Woh myn flesch idt und van mynen blode drinket, de blifft in my und ick in eme, und ick werde ehm ahm jungesten dage wedder upwecken. Tom anderen denet uns ock darto, dat wy unsen geloven ahn de tosagen des evangelii van vorgevinge der sunden darmede alße mit rynen, gottlichen, umbedrechlichen segel und pande vorwyssen. Tom drudden, datt wy unsers Heren Christi doedt vorkundigen wente to syner wedderkumpst, dat is, datt wy ehme unse levedage vor de vorlosinge danken, de nicht dorch golt offte sulver (wo Petrus secht ), sunder dorch syn durbar offer und blodtvorgeten gescheen is. Tom latesten leren disse wort, wol dejennen syn, de datt hillige sacrament salich to vorgevinge erer sunden entfangen, nomlicken nicht de huchelers, de allene botverdich vor denn mynschen erschynen und doch ere sundlicke levent nicht denken to beteren, sunder blyven na als vor vul untucht, haet, nydt, woker, valscheit, bedroch und dergelicken, disse eten und drinken sick sulven (wo Paulus secht ) dat gerichte. Dejennen averst, de ere sunden van harten beruwen und dersülvigen vorgevinge dorch dat lyden, sterven und blodtvorgeten Christi vaste geloven und mit ernst ere levent denken to beteren und alßo hungerick und dorstich na der gnade und barmharticheit dutt hillige sacrament entfangen, so vaken se datt doen, warden se hie van Christo vorwysset, datt en ere sunde vorgeven und nicht schal gedacht warden.
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> Up datt wy nu datt hillige sacramente werdigen mogen entfangen, so bedet mit my also: Herr Godt, barmhartige Vader, wy bidden, help uns dach [!] to eyner waren bote und bedecke unse sunde und unwerdicheit mit der werdicheit dines leven Sons Jhesu Christi, unseren Heren, und gyff, dat wy dut hilige sacrament to sterkinge unses gelovens van vorgevinge der sunden entfangen und in eynem nyen levende wassen und tonemen, up dat wy also mit der werdicheit dynes Sons bekledet, ewyich salich mogen werden, dorch densulven dynen Soenn, unsen Heren Christum. Amen.

My dear Christians, all that will consider and keep this holy Supper of our Lord Jesus Christ fruitfully to their salvation, it is highly needful that before all things they know firmly the words of the institution of this Supper, as the holy evangelists and Paul have written them, which run thus: Our Lord Jesus Christ, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, eat; this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also he took the cup after supper, gave thanks, gave it them, and said: Drink ye all of it; this cup is the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you for the remission of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.

Whoso considereth these words diligently, he findeth therein all that a godly Christian needeth to know of this holy sacrament, as: First, what this holy sacrament is, namely the true body and the true blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is given us under bread and wine to eat and to drink, to sustain therewith not the body but the soul. Secondly, these words teach who hath

instituted and ordained this sacrament, namely no emperor, kings, man or angel, but our Lord Jesus Christ himself, the emperor of all emperors, king of all kings, the Lord of the angels and of all creatures, the redeemer of mankind, the only-begotten Son of God, who is with the Father and the Holy Ghost of like power and truth, whose will and words come truly to pass and deceive no man, though it seemed to our reason incomprehensible and impossible. Thirdly, these words teach whereto the holy sacrament is profitable and useful to us, namely, first, that we thereby are incorporated into our Lord Christ in faith, and he become one with us and we one with him, unto eternal life, as he himself saith, John 6[:56 and 54]: Whoso eateth my flesh and drinketh of my blood dwelleth in me and I in him, and I will raise him up again at the last day. Secondly, it serveth us also thereto, that we thereby assure our faith in the promises of the gospel of the forgiveness of sins, as with a pure, divine, undeceiving seal and pledge. Thirdly, that we show forth the death of our Lord Christ until his coming again, that is, that we thank him all the days of our life for the redemption, which hath come to pass not through gold or silver (as Peter saith), but through his precious sacrifice and bloodshedding. Lastly, these words teach who they are that receive the holy sacrament savingly to the forgiveness of their sins, namely not the hypocrites, who appear penitent only before men and yet think not to amend their sinful life, but remain after as before full of unchastity, hatred, envy, usury, falsehood, deceit and the like; these eat and drink (as Paul saith) judgment to themselves. But they that repent of their sins from the heart, and firmly believe the forgiveness thereof through the passion, death and bloodshedding of Christ, and earnestly think to amend their life, and so receive this holy sacrament hungry and thirsty for grace and mercy, as oft as they do it, they are here assured by Christ that their sins are forgiven them and shall not be remembered.

That we may now receive the holy sacrament worthily, pray with me thus: Lord God, merciful Father, we beseech thee, help us yet to a true repentance, and cover our sins and unworthiness with the worthiness of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, our Lord, and grant that we may receive this holy sacrament to the strengthening of our faith in the forgiveness of sins, and grow and increase in a new life, that we, thus clothed with the worthiness of thy Son, may be eternally saved, through the same thy Son, our Lord Christ. Amen.

**What follows.** "Eyn ander" (another): the editor notes that the order then gives the exhortation "Myn alderlevesten in Godt", which Lüneburg 1564 also has in High German, that is, the Braunschweig recension of Osiander (§3.5.4), and that Buxtehude adds the wish "Datt vorlene uns Godt alle, dat wy idt werdichlick entfangen. Amen" (God grant this to us all, that we receive it worthily. Amen; Sehling 7/1, p. 125). Buxtehude is thus also a witness of §3.5.4.

#### 3.5.14.4 Micron, London 1554, German 1565

Micron's order for the Dutch stranger church at London (Reformed), in the German version of 1565 (with the Norden Dutch variants), has the minister read the institution from 1 Cor 11 from the pulpit and then exhort the congregation to examine itself "ihe sie an den tisch des Herren sitze" (before it sit at the table of the Lord). **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), German 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 631–633):

> Ihr habt, lieben brüder, auß dieser lehre des heiligen apostels Pauli gehöret, wer der einsetzer des nachtmals sey, nemlich Christus Jesus, und wie es sol gehalten werden, es sey denn, das man in grosse gefahr der seelen fallen wil. Denn sie werden schuldig an dem leib und blut Christi, essen und trinken ihnen selbs das gericht, die es unwirdig empfahen. Auf daß wir denn diser gefahr entfliehen und das nachtmal des Herren wirdiglich niessen mögen, so lasset uns, ihe wir an den tisch des Herren sitzen, fleissig anhören, warin (nach der heiligen schrift) die rechte niessung des nachtmals gelegen sey. Dieselbige stellet hie der apostel Paulus für in unserer prüffung und in dem underscheiden des leibs des Herren, also daß ein jeder, der sich selbs […] aufrichtig prüffet und den leib des Heeren underscheidet, wirdiglich zu seiner seelen trost und seligkeit zum nachtmal des Herren geht. Diese prüffung aber und underscheidung des leibs des Herren oder seines opfers, durch welches er seinen leib für uns in den tod gegeben hat, ist in dreien stücken fürnemlich gelegen. Zum ersten, daß wir unsere sünden, die wir wider Gott und unsern nechsten getan haben, von herzen bekennen und beweinen und uns (sofern es müglich) warhaftig mit allen denen versünen, mit welchen wir etwas widerwertiges haben. Zum andern, das wir in der erkentnuß unser sünden und in der empfindnuß des zorns Gottes gegen uns nicht kleinmütig werden umb unser sünden willen noch in verzweifelung fallen an seiner güte gegen uns, auch unsere zuflucht nicht nemen zu menschlichen verdiensten, sonder sollen festiglich glauben, daß uns alle unsere sünden allein auß lauter gnaden umbsonst vergeben werden durch das einige verdienst des tods Christi, gleich ob wir den todt selber in unser eignen person am stammen des kreuzes gelidten hetten. Zum dritten ist das rechte prüffen unsers gewissens hierin gelegen, das wir einfeltig one gleißnerey vor uns nemen ein aufrichtige besserung des lebens nach dem heiligen willen Gottes. Hierin soll denn ein jeder sein eigen herz und gewissen fleissig undersuchen, wie er sich selbs gerüst find gegen Gott und seinen nechsten; denn welcher halßstarrig in seinen sünden wil bleiben, als in abgötterey, lästerung, geiz,

> stelen, liegen, betriegen, haderen, volsaufen, unreinigkeit und dergleichen, oder der seine sünden bekennet und doch in jemand anders beruwet denn in Jesu Christo und in dem verdienst seines tods, oder der nicht von ganzem herzen one gleißnerey vor sich nimpt, ein besser leben zu füren, derselbige sol nu, zu dem nachtmal des Herren zu kommen, nicht eilen. So aber jemand anders hierin handlen wurde, wie heimlich auch dasselbige geschehe, wird er doch vor dem angesicht Gottes schuldig sein des tods Christi, welchen er also verunehrt und verachtet.
>
> Diß sagen wir dennoch darumb nicht, lieben brüder, als wolten wir die zerschlagene herzen der glaubigen kleinmütig machen, als wen niemand zu dem nachtmal des Herren möcht gehn, denn der von aller unreinigkeit der sünden frey und in aller heiligkeit volkommen sey. Denn Christus der Herr hat sein nachtmal nicht eingesetzt zu einem zeugnuß unser heiligkeit oder volkommenheit, sonder vielmehr zu einem zeugnuß unser unvolkommenheit und ungerechtigkeit, welche er von uns hinnimpt durch das opfer seines leibs und rechent uns seine gerechtigkeit und ehre zu, ja, schenket uns dieselbige. Und darumb kommen die gläubigen zu dem tisch des Herren nit, daß sie sich ihrer gerechtigkeit und fromkeit rümen, sonder vilmehr zu bezeugen, daß sie auß ihnen selbs nichts anders sünd [!] denn kinder des zorns, under die sind [!] verkauft und unwirdig, ihre augen gehn himmel aufzuheben, welcher gerechtigkeit, volkommenheit und heiligkeit allein Christus ist, der alle unsere krankheit auf sich durch sein kreuz genomen hat und geust uns ein durch den heiligen Geist ein rechte lust zu der gerechtigkeit.
>
> Derhalben, so vil er under uns sind, die zum trost ihres gewissens mit dem hochzeitlichen kleide an den tisch des Herren sitzen wollen: Lasset uns unß selbs von ganzem herzen der sünden halben beschüldigen und vestiglich glauben, daß sie uns allein umb Christus willen nicht zugerechnet werden. Lasset uns auch für uns nemmen ein ernstliche besserung des lebens. Und auf daß wir die süssigkeit des verdienstes des tods Christi in dem gebrauch des nachtmals in unsern herzen kreftiglich empfinden und geniessen mögen, so sollen wir nit kleben bleiben in der eusserlichen ubung oder in den elementen des brots und weins, sonder dardurch vermanet, müssen wir unsere sinne, herzen und verstand hinauf in himmel erheben, da Jesus Christus allein nach dem leib ist, ein getreuer fürsprecher für uns, und dardurch sollen wir ungezweifelt versichert sein, daß wir viel gewisser durch die geistliche gemeinschaft des leibs und bluts Christi zu dem ewigen leben gespeiset werden, denn unsere sterbliche leibe durch speise und trank teglich underhalten werden, und denn wir in dem nachtmal des Herren brot und wein nach dem befelch Christi niessen. Gott, unser himlischer Vater, wolle uns seine gnade geben, daß wir die warhaftige speise unser seelen Jesum Christum in unserm gewissen warhaftig zu dem ewigen leben schmecken mögen. Amen.

Ye have heard, dear brethren, out of this doctrine of the holy apostle Paul, who is the institutor of the Supper, namely Christ Jesus, and how it shall be kept, unless one will fall into great danger of the soul. For they that receive it unworthily become guilty of the body and blood of Christ, and eat and drink judgment to themselves. That we then may flee this danger and enjoy the Supper of the Lord worthily, let us, before we sit at the table of the Lord, hear diligently wherein (according to the holy scripture) the right eating of the Supper lieth. The same doth the apostle Paul here set forth in our proving and in the discerning of the body of the Lord, so that every one that sincerely proveth himself and discerneth the body of the Lord goeth worthily to the Supper of the Lord to his soul's comfort and salvation. But this proving and discerning of the body of the Lord, or of his sacrifice, whereby he hath given his body into death for us, lieth chiefly in three points. First, that we confess and bewail from the heart our sins, which we have done against God and our neighbour, and truly reconcile ourselves (so far as it be possible) with all those with whom we have aught at variance. Secondly, that in the knowledge of our sins and in the feeling of the wrath of God against us we become not faint-hearted for our sins' sake, nor fall into despair of his goodness toward us, nor yet take our refuge in human merits, but shall firmly believe that all our sins are forgiven us only out of pure grace, freely, through the only merit of the death of Christ, even as if we ourselves had suffered the death in our own person on the tree of the cross. Thirdly, the right proving of our conscience lieth herein, that we simply, without hypocrisy, purpose a sincere amendment of life according to the holy will of God. Herein then shall every one diligently search his own heart and conscience, how he findeth himself prepared toward God and his neighbour; for whoso will remain stiff-necked in his sins, as in idolatry, blasphemy, covetousness, stealing, lying, deceiving, quarrelling, drunkenness, uncleanness and the like, or who confesseth his sins and yet trusteth in any other than in Jesus Christ and in the merit of his death, or who purposeth not with his whole heart, without hypocrisy, to lead a better life, the same shall not now make haste to come to the Supper of the Lord. But if any should deal otherwise herein, however secretly the same be done, he shall yet before the face of God be guilty of the death of Christ, whom he thus dishonoureth and despiseth.

Yet we say not this, dear brethren, as though we would make the broken hearts of the faithful faint, as if none might go to the Supper of the Lord but he that is free from all uncleanness of sins and perfect in all holiness. For Christ the Lord hath not instituted his Supper for a witness of our holiness or perfection, but much rather for a witness of our imperfection and

unrighteousness, which he taketh from us by the sacrifice of his body, and reckoneth to us his righteousness and honour, yea, giveth us the same. And therefore the faithful come to the table of the Lord, not that they may boast of their righteousness and godliness, but much rather to testify that of themselves they are nothing else than children of wrath, sold under sin, and unworthy to lift up their eyes to heaven, whose righteousness, perfection and holiness is Christ alone, who hath taken all our sickness upon himself through his cross, and poureth into us through the Holy Ghost a right desire for righteousness.

Therefore, as many of us as will sit at the table of the Lord for the comfort of their conscience with the wedding garment: Let us accuse ourselves with our whole heart for our sins, and firmly believe that they are not imputed to us, only for Christ's sake. Let us also purpose an earnest amendment of life. And that we may mightily feel and enjoy in our hearts the sweetness of the merit of the death of Christ in the use of the Supper, we shall not remain cleaving to the outward exercise or to the elements of bread and wine, but, admonished thereby, we must lift up our senses, hearts and understanding into heaven, where Jesus Christ alone is according to the body, a faithful advocate for us; and thereby we shall be assured without doubt that we are fed unto eternal life through the spiritual communion of the body and blood of Christ much more surely than our mortal bodies are daily sustained by meat and drink, and than we eat bread and wine in the Supper of the Lord according to the commandment of Christ. God, our heavenly Father, give us his grace, that we may truly taste the true food of our souls, Jesus Christ, in our conscience unto eternal life. Amen.

**Notes.**

- **The place.** It is read after the Verba, from the pulpit; the minister then goes down to the table and announces 1 Cor 5:7f. ("Nach diser vermanung gehet der diener von der kanzel und stellet sich zu den andern dinern bey dem tisch", after this exhortation the minister goeth from the pulpit and standeth with the other ministers by the table; Sehling 7/1, p. 633).
- **Sources.** Sehling's editor compares the second point, on the forgiveness won "am galgen des krützes" (on the gallows of the cross), with the third exhortation of Gellius Faber of Emden (Reformed) (Sehling 7/1, p. 632).
- **The *Sursum corda* turned to a doctrine.** "Wir müssen unsere sinne, herzen und verstand hinauf in himmel erheben, da Jesus Christus allein nach dem leib ist" (we must lift up our senses, hearts and understanding into heaven, where Jesus Christ alone is according to the body) is the Reformed reading of *Sursum corda*.
- **Moers** (Reformed). The Lower Rhine recension of the Palatinate exhortation (§3.5.10) opens with Micron's words: "Auß dieser lehr deß heiligen apostels Pauli hört ihr …" (Out of this doctrine of the holy apostle Paul ye hear …).

#### 3.5.14.5 Three short notes

- **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593.** After communion "tut der prediger ein kurze vermanung von der liebe des nehesten" (the preacher maketh a short exhortation of the love of the neighbour), on 1 Cor 10:17 and the figure of many grains and grapes made into one bread and one wine. It turns into the thanksgiving: "so hebet nun eure herzen zu Godt (ihr geliebten) und last uns frolick danksagen" (so lift up now your hearts to God, beloved, and let us joyfully give thanks; Sehling 7/1, p. 713). The image of grains and grapes is the one that closes the Palatinate exhortation of 1563 (Reformed; §3.5.10). Sehling's editor also describes the Low German Nürnberg hospital Mass, "De düdesche Misse" of a Hamburg hymnal of 1558, which has both the Nürnberg and the Bugenhagen exhortations after the *Agnus Dei* (p. 714).
- **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578.** Besides the Brandenburg-Nürnberg exhortation at the altar (§3.5.5), the order appends "Vermanungen vom heiligen abendmal, an dem sambstag zur vesper den beichtkindern und communicanten vorzulesen" (exhortations of the holy Supper, to be read at Saturday Vespers to the penitents and communicants; Sehling 15, p. 327). They are a cycle of eight teaching homilies with a common opening, "Lieben freunde Christi. Dieweil wir morgendes tags das hochwirdige und heilige abendmal … zu halten gedenken" (Dear friends of Christ, forasmuch as we purpose to keep tomorrow the most worthy and holy Supper), which begins with the words of Luther's address (§3.5.3). The editor traces them to the Saturday sermons of Johann Hofmann (pp. 243, 328).
- **Mecklenburg 1540/45.** Its three Low German exhortations are not printed by Sehling (§3.5.2).

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## 3.6 Before and after the service

### 3.6.1 Vesting prayers

**No vesting prayers survive.** None of the evangelical orders in Sehling prints or appoints a vesting prayer, or any of the other prayers in the Lutheran Missal Project's *Vesting Prayers*:

- the psalms of preparation (84, 85, 86, 116, 130) with the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris*;
- the Kyrie, Our Father and *preces*;
- the collects;
- the prayers before vesting, at the washing of the hands, and at the amice, alb, cincture, maniple, stole, tunicle, chasuble and mitre.

The searches covered the Latin incipits (*Ne reminiscaris*, *Quam dilecta*, *Benedixisti*, *Inclina, Domine*, *Credidi*, *De profundis* in a preparatory setting), *praeparatio ad missam*, *amictus*, *indue me*, and the German and Low German words for vesting. The psalms occur only in the Office and the Introits.

The only mention of the medieval prayers is an editor's note. Sehling's editor, on the Amberg hospital order of 1544, distinguishes the three preparations of the priest before Mass. **Amberg, *Ordnung der kirchen … im spital*, 1544, editor's note** (Sehling 13, p. 282):

> Was hier in diesem beachtenswerten Versuch als Rüsthandlung für die Gemeinde anstatt des Stufengebetes (mit dem Confiteor) als einer Rüsthandlung des zelebrierenden Geistlichen vor den Introitus gesetzt ist, ist wahrscheinlich eine Form des Akzesses. Dieser ist die erste der drei vorgeschriebenen Rüsthandlungen des Geistlichen. Diese war nicht - wie die auf ihn folgende Praeparatio ad missam (u.a. mit den Gebeten bei Anlegung der einzelnen Bestandteile der Meßkleidung) und die dann schon in der Messe selbst in Gestalt des Stufengebetes - im Meßbuch ihrer Form nach genau vorgeschrieben, konnte daher örtlich und persönlich durchaus verschieden sein und auch die Form einer Andacht, mit der Priester sich gemeinsam auf die Feier der Messe vorbereiteten, annehmen

What is here set before the Introit, in this noteworthy attempt, as a preparation for the congregation instead of the prayers at the foot of the altar (with the Confiteor), which are a preparation of the celebrating clergyman, is probably a form of the *accessus*. This is the first of the three prescribed preparations of the clergyman. It was not, like the *Praeparatio ad missam* that followed it (with, among other things, the prayers at the putting on of the several parts of the Mass vesture), and that which then came within the Mass itself in the form of the prayers at the foot of the altar, exactly prescribed in its form in the Missal, and could therefore differ quite widely by place and person, and could also take the form of a devotion with which priests prepared themselves together for the celebration of Mass.

**What the orders do say about vesting.** The orders mention vesting only as a rubric, and only to say that it signifies nothing. The vestments themselves are indifferent. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 65):

> Die andern zusetz eusserlicher leiblicher ding, als messgewand, altardeck, silbern und gülden gefess, lichter etc. sein aller ding frei, geben und nemen dem glauben und gewissen nichts. Darum dieweil sie vorhin verhanden und gezeuget sein, sol man sie behalten und brauchen, sonderlich die kleider darum, das die diener der kirchen nicht alweg in iren eigen kleidern also gestalt sein, das sie darinnen tapfer und ehrlich der gemein mochten dienen.

The other additions of outward bodily things, as Mass vestment, altar cloth, silver and golden vessels, lights, etc., are altogether free; they give and take nothing to faith and conscience. Therefore, since they were there before and have been provided, they shall be kept and used, especially the vestments, because the ministers of the church are not always so furnished in their own clothes that they might serve the congregation therein worthily and honourably.

The rubrics on vesting say no more than this:

- **The moment of vesting.** At Hadeln the priest vests during the *Te Deum* at the end of Matins, "nicht alse nödig, sundern als ein düchtig erbarlich zirath, und nicht darinne de saligkeit soken" (not as needful, but as a seemly and honest ornament, and not seeking salvation therein; §3.3.4). In Mecklenburg 1540 the priest turns to the people "wenn he sick hefft angekledet" (when he hath vested himself; §3.3.4). In both, vesting is done in silence, in the church or sacristy, with no prayer.
- **The *Stufengebet***, the third of the medieval preparations, is the only one that survives (§3.3.2–3.3.4). The *accessus* survives, recast, only as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (§3.3.7).

### 3.6.2 The psalms and the *Ne reminiscaris*

None of the five preparatory psalms of the Missal's *praeparatio* is appointed as a private preparation of the minister, and the antiphon *Ne reminiscaris* (Tobit 3:3) does not occur.

- **The nearest thing** is Bugenhagen's *Domine, ne memineris iniquitatum nostrarum antiquarum* (Ps 79:8), said with the sexton at the altar step (§3.3.3). It is the same plea for the forgetting of old sins, but taken from the Lenten tract.
- **Penitential psalms.** Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 allows "ein feinen bußpsalm" (a goodly penitential psalm) in place of the *Confiteor* (§3.3.2). Ps 130 *De profundis* appears as a hymn, Luther's *Aus tiefer Not*, sung as the Introit in Lippe (§3.3.4) and often elsewhere.
- **The psalms themselves** occur in the corpus only as Introits, Office psalms, or proof texts. Ps 84 *Quam dilecta* is the dedication psalm at Hof 1592 (Sehling 11, p. 422), and Lüneburg 1564 cites it in defence of public worship (Sehling 6/1, p. 541).

### 3.6.3 After the Mass

**The priest's private thanksgiving.** The medieval *gratiarum actio post missam* (the canticle *Benedicite*, Ps 150 *Laudate Dominum in sanctis eius*, and collects, said by the priest while unvesting) survives in only one form. In Bugenhagen's Hildesheim order of 1544 and the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542, the priest unvests during the closing hymn, kneels again before the altar, and "danket Godde hemelick vor sick sülvest" (thanketh God secretly for himself; Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855; Sehling 23, p. 91). No text is given. Both are quoted with translations in Chapter 7 §§7.15.2–7.15.3.

**The Benedicite and Ps 150.** Neither is appointed after Mass in any evangelical order. Both occur only as the canticle and psalm of **Sunday Lauds**, sung in the choir by the schoolboys or the canons. Pomerania prescribes the weekday canticles of Lauds after the *Te Deum*. **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 349):

> Post tertium responsorium, quod cum gloria patri etc. canitur, sequatur te deum etc. Mox cantor incipiat aliquam antiphonam, secundum cuius tonum canatur tantum unus ex psalmis prophetalibus, quae cantica vocantur. — Dominica die: Benedicite omnia etc. -— Feria secunda: Confitebor tibi, domine, quoniam iratus etc. — Feria tertia: Ego dixi etc. —- Feria quarta: Exultavit etc. — Feria quinta: Cantemus etc. — Feria sexta: Domine, audivi etc. — Sabbato: Audite coeli etc.

After the third responsory, which is sung with the Gloria Patri, etc., let the Te Deum follow, etc. Next let the cantor begin some antiphon, according to whose tone there shall be sung only one of the prophetic psalms, which are called canticles: on the Lord's Day, *Benedicite omnia*, etc.; on Monday, *Confitebor tibi, Domine, quoniam iratus*, etc.; on Tuesday, *Ego dixi*, etc.; on Wednesday, *Exultavit*, etc.; on Thursday, *Cantemus*, etc.; on Friday, *Domine, audivi*, etc.; on Saturday, *Audite coeli*, etc.

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 has the same scheme in Low German, "des Sondages: Benedicite Omnia etc." (on Sundays: *Benedicite omnia*; Sehling 23, p. 141). At the Ansbach collegiate churches Sunday Lauds keeps both the *Benedicite* and the *Laudate* psalms. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 313):

> Am sontag singen sie das Te Deum laudamus. Darnach die psalmen Dominus regnavit, Jubilate Deo omnis terra, Deus Deus meus, Benedicite omnia opera, Laudate Dominum de coelis mit der antiphona Indutus est, Benedictus Dominus etc., wie man sunst gewonlich am sontag helt.

On Sunday they sing the Te Deum laudamus; thereafter the psalms *Dominus regnavit*, *Jubilate Deo omnis terra*, *Deus, Deus meus*, *Benedicite omnia opera*, *Laudate Dominum de coelis*, with the antiphon *Indutus est*; the *Benedictus Dominus*, etc., as is otherwise customarily held on Sunday.

**Who sings them.** At Ansbach, "sie": the canons and vicars of the collegiate foundations. In Pomerania and Schleswig-Holstein, the cantor and the schoolboys in the choir. The people are not present at Lauds. The *Laudate* psalms (Pss 148–150) are sung under the one heading "Laudate Dominum de coelis".

**What the orders do appoint after Mass.** In place of the priest's private thanksgiving, the evangelical Mass ends with a public thanksgiving by all:

- a postcommunion collect, usually Luther's "Wir danken dir, allmächtiger Herr Gott";
- the Aaronic blessing;
- a hymn or psalm sung by the schoolboys and people while the communicants return, or at the very end. At Hildesheim it is "einen düdeschen, korten psalm" (a short German psalm) begun by the schoolmaster.

In Kantz 1522 and in Nürnberg the *Nunc dimittis* is sung after communion. The collects and thanksgiving prayers are treated in Chapter 5, and the hymns in Chapter 8.

### 3.6.4 Prayers before and after the sermon

**The pattern.** Every Lutheran order surrounds the sermon with prayer. The preacher calls the people to prayer before he begins, and they pray, usually the Our Father in silence or aloud, or sing a hymn to the Holy Ghost. At the end of the sermon he calls them again to thanksgiving and to intercession for the Church, the government and all need, and leads the general prayer. The Lüneburg order puts it most fully. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 544–545):

> Aber vor der predigt hat der priester das volk zum christlichen gebet zu vermanen, das der liebe Gott ihnen seinen heiligen Geist geben wolle, sein heiliges wort nützbarlich zu handeln […] und in das herze zu fassen, das sie ihr sündlich leben bessern, trost und sterkung ihres glaubens erlangen und hinfurt christlich und seliglich leben mögen. Darauf sol man ein Vater unser sprechen oder singen: Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist. Umb die Weihnachten: Ein kindelein so löbelich etc. Umb die Ostern: Christ ist erstanden etc. Zum ende der predigt sol das volk abermal zum gebet und danksagung gegen Gott vermanet werden und samptlich vor erhaltung der kirchen Gottes und rechter lere, darzu der treuen warhaftigen lerer und das Gott treue arbeiter in seine ernte senden wolle, für die oberkeit, für zeitlichen friede und gewechs der früchte und in summa für die not der ganzen christenheit und sonderbarer personen, die des christlichen gebets begeren

But before the sermon the priest is to exhort the people to Christian prayer, that the dear God would give them his Holy Ghost, to handle his holy word profitably and to take it into the heart, that they may amend their sinful life, obtain comfort and strengthening of their faith, and henceforth live christianly and blessedly. Thereupon an Our Father shall be said, or *Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist* sung; about Christmas, *Ein kindelein so löbelich*, etc.; about Easter, *Christ ist erstanden*, etc. At the end of the sermon the people shall again be exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving toward God, and [shall pray] together for the preservation of the Church of God and right doctrine, and thereto of faithful, true teachers, and that God would send faithful labourers into his harvest; for the government, for temporal peace and the increase of the fruits; and in sum for the need of all Christendom and of particular persons that desire the Christian prayer.

**Other orders.**

- **Luther 1526**: "das man auf der cantzel gemein gebet thut oder das vater unser fur spricht" (that the common prayer is made in the pulpit, or the Our Father said before [the people]), remains from the old pulpit office (§3.5.3).
- **Mecklenburg 1552**: at the end of the sermon the people are "zum gebet und danksagung … vermanet" (exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving), and the preacher is to bid them "das sie in der kirchen bei der communio bleiben" (that they remain in the church at the communion) (Sehling 5, p. 198). Lüneburg copies it.
- **Hadeln**: the preacher "schall thom ersten dat volk vormahnen tho vlitiger anropinge der hulpe gades" (shall first exhort the people to diligent calling upon the help of God). After the sermon he again exhorts to prayer, recites the Small Catechism, and prays for the prince, the preachers "und alle nothsaken" (and all needs) (Sehling 5, p. 468).
- **Buxtehude 1552**: the chaplains "scholen … alle ore predige mit gesange, Godt umme syne gnade to bidden, ahnfangen" (shall begin all their sermons with a hymn, to pray God for his grace; Sehling 7/1, p. 72).
- **Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573**, weekday sermons: "fur der Predig eynen Psalmen singen. Dem folg ein Vater unser und die Predig. Letzlich beschließ die Predig mit dem Gesang, Gebet und Segen" (before the sermon sing a psalm; then follow an Our Father and the sermon; lastly close the sermon with hymn, prayer and blessing; Sehling 20/2, p. 53). In the villages without a school the pastor sings a German psalm, then "erzele er die offne Beicht, Absolution und Epistel" (let him recite the open confession, absolution and epistle; ibid.).
- **Palatinate 1563** (Reformed): the prayer of confession before the sermon, ending in the Our Father, said by the minister (§3.3.6); the confession, absolution and the long general prayer after it (§3.4.4).

The pulpit prayers, the greeting and the notices are treated more fully in Chapter 11 §11.10.

**Who prays.** The preacher bids and leads; the congregation prays the Our Father with him or silently, and answers "Amen". The schoolboys and choir sing the hymn. No order gives a private prayer for the preacher to say before going up into the pulpit. Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has him begin the sermon "mitt dem gebett, wie breuchlich" (with the prayer, as is customary; Sehling 18, p. 499), and leaves the text to custom.

### 3.6.5 On entering and leaving church; the communicants' own prayers

**On entering church.** No order in the corpus prints or appoints a prayer for the worshipper to say on entering or leaving the church. The modern hymnal's "prayer on entering church" has no sixteenth-century church-order counterpart. What the orders appoint "when one comes into church" is a hymn:

- **Sayn 1590**: "Erstlich, wann man in die Kirche kompt, soll man einen Teutschen Psalm singen. Darnach soll der Pfarrherr ein Collect lesen" (First, when one cometh into the church, a German psalm shall be sung; thereafter the pastor shall read a collect; Sehling 19/1, p. 412).
- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557**: an opening hymn of the Holy Ghost is sung "biß die Kirch zusammen kombt" (until the church cometh together; §3.3.4).
- **Amberg 1550**, weekday morning prayer: the priest begins *Deus in adiutorium*, and the choir sings one or two Latin psalms "bis das volk zusammenkumbt" (until the people come together; Sehling 13, p. 287).

The orders regulate behaviour instead: the people are not to stand about in the churchyard or run in and out during the sermon. The village ordinance of Obereisenheim (Castell) of 1579 wants each to go into church when the bell is rung, to "Gottes wort hören, der predigt auswarten und sein gebet mit einer ganzen gemeind ruhig und still volbringen" (hear God's word, wait upon the sermon, and finish his prayer with the whole congregation quietly and still; Sehling 11, p. 688).

**The communicants' prayers.** The orders print no private prayers for the communicant to say before or after receiving. What the communicant does is set out in three ways:

1. **Private preparation** by confession and examination on the Saturday (§3.4.6).
2. **Prayers said for them by the minister**:
    - Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has a "Gebett vor dem Abendmal", read by the minister to the people after the absolution. It asks "du wöllest uns allen, die wir von disem deinem heiligen abendtmal essen unnd trinckhen werden, die seelige gemeinschafft deines leibs und bluts gnediglich schenckhen" (that thou wouldest graciously give unto all of us that shall eat and drink of this thy holy Supper the blessed communion of thy body and blood; Sehling 18, p. 499).
    - Micron's Dutch order (Reformed) has a "Gebett vor dem nachtmal" (prayer before the Supper), said by the minister from the pulpit while all kneel (Sehling 7/1, p. 630).
    - Ysenburg 1588 prints more than one prayer after communion, all collects of the minister (Sehling 10, p. 627).
3. **Hymns sung during the distribution.** *Jesus Christus unser Heiland*, *Gott sei gelobet*, the German *Agnus Dei*: the hymns are the people's prayer during communion. Mecklenburg 1552 tells the communicants "ir solt auch hiebei euer herzlich gebet thun" (ye shall also here make your hearty prayer), and gives the prayer in the first person, to be made their own (§3.5.9).

**The hymnal.** The nearest thing to the modern hymnal's printed devotions is the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Gesangbuch* of 1571/1587. It reprints the Mecklenburg confession, prayer and absolution as "Beicht, Gebett und Absolutio vor der Predig am Sontag" (Confession, prayer and absolution before the sermon on Sunday), so that the people had the text in their hands (Sehling 18, p. 187, apparatus).

**A note on "Benedicite".** In the household sections of the orders, "Benedicite" and "Gratias" are the grace before and after meat of Luther's Small Catechism ("Aller augen warten auff dich, Herr" and "Dancket dem Herrn, dann er ist freundlich"). It is not the canticle of the three children. Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 heads it "Wie ein Haußvater sein Gesinde soll leren, das Benedicite und Gratias sprechen" (How a householder shall teach his household to say the Benedicite and Gratias; Sehling 18, p. 180).

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## 3.7 Table by order

The table gives, for each order discussed in §3.3 and §3.4 and for the orders with an exhortation of their own (§3.5.14), what stands before the Introit, how the confession is said and absolved, and where the exhortation falls. Every cell has been checked against the text of the order. "—" means the order has nothing of the kind; "not stated" means the order mentions the item but gives no text or form. "A"–"G" are the families of §3.3.1; absolution types 1–5 are those of §3.4.4. The orders that appear only as witnesses to an exhortation are listed in the witness tables of §3.5.3–3.5.13.

| Order | Opening before the Introit | Confession: who and where | Absolution (type) | Exhortation (family; place) | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kantz, Nördlingen 1522 | Exhortation, absolution, *Adiutorium*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (D) | No confession text; before the Sacrament | "sag euch frei, ledig und los" (3) | Free, with a short address leading to the absolution; before the Preface | 3.3.5, 3.4.3, 3.5.14.1 |
| Müntzer, Allstedt 1523 and 1524 (Radical Reformation) | Ps 43 with priest and people; priest's confession; people's *Misereatur*; *Deus, tu conversus*; *Non nobis*; *Aufer a nobis* (G) | Priest, aloud "vor allem volk"; the people answer | — | — | 3.3.8 |
| Volprecht, Nürnberg 1524 | *Offene beicht* "anstatt des Confiteor" (D) | Priest, to God and the brothers and sisters | "Gott hat sich unser erbarmet" (2) | Osiander (V); printed after the Mass, for days with communicants | 3.3.5, 3.5.4 |
| Wertheim 1524 (Kolb) | Sermon | Priest kneeling, "Confiteor brevissimum" in German, after the sermon | — | None before communion ("sine omni adhortatione"); a short exhortation to thanksgiving after communion, and one "pro praeparatione" in the sermon | 3.3.6 |
| Döber, Nürnberg 1525 | Address, *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, confession, *Misereatur*, declaration, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (C) | Priest kneeling; people "sprecht mir nach" | Optative (1), then declaration (2) | Osiander; after the Our Father | 3.3.4, 3.5.4 |
| Bremen, *Evangelische Misse*, 1525 | Address, absolution, *Adiutorium*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (D) | No confession text; the priest asks the people's prayer ("Bicht des presters") | "vorkundige iw fry, ledich unde los" (3) | Free, with Kantz's address in Low German; before the Preface | 3.3.5, 3.5.14.1 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe* 1526 | German hymn or psalm (F) | — | — | Luther; after the sermon, pulpit or altar | 3.3.7, 3.5.3 |
| Hadeln ("1526") | Priest vests during the *Te Deum*; *Veni Sancte Spiritus* kneeling (C, F) | Priest sings it kneeling; the sexton answers | Read by the sexton; later given up | Bugenhagen ("Mine allerlevesten etc."); after the sermon, before the Preface | 3.3.4, 3.5.7 |
| Kiel, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526] | Address and confession (C) | Priest; minister and sexton read the *Misereatur* | Read by the sexton (3) | After the Preface and bread-word (Chapter 7 §7.11.3) | 3.3.4 |
| Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [1525–1538] | *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, confession (C) | Priest reads it while the choir sings the Introit | Optative, headed "absolutio" (1) | — (Creed, offertory hymn, Preface) | 3.3.4 |

| Order | Opening before the Introit | Confession: who and where | Absolution (type) | Exhortation (family; place) | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bugenhagen, Brunswick 1528 | Introit or German psalm | Preacher and people, from the pulpit after the sermon, with the Creed | None; "Jesus Christus is unse salicheit" (5) | Bugenhagen; at the altar, in place of the Preface | 3.4.4, 3.5.7 |
| Augsburg, St. Anna, 1530 (Moderate Reformed) | Not stated (the order covers the Supper only) | None in the first form | In the second exhortation: "sprech ich euch alle … ledig von euren sunden" (3) | Two of its own; before the Verba and after them | 3.5.14.2 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 | Priest's *Confiteor* "oder, was ine sein andacht erinnert" (A) | Priest alone | — (the *Offene Schuld* added at Nürnberg after 1569) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg; after the sermon, before the Verba | 3.3.2, 3.5.5 |
| Württemberg 1536 | *Veni Sancte* in German, psalms (Saturday admonition in the choir) | Pastor says it for all after the exhortation | Three forms, indicative (3) | Württemberg; at the altar after the sermon | 3.4.4, 3.5.6 |
| Naumburg 1537 | *Kom heiliger geist* sung by the choir (D, F) | Priest leads; people say it | "vorgebe ich euch all eure sunde" (3) | Naumburg; to the communicants gathered in the choir, before the Sanctus | 3.3.5, 3.5.8 |
| Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | "Confiteor oder offene schuld" (E) | Minister; each "in seinem hertzen" | Comfortable word, conditional (4) | Free: at the end of the sermon, in four points, or briefly after the prayer and Our Father, before the Verba | 3.3.6 |
| Mecklenburg 1540/45 | Address, *Adiutorium*, *Confitemini*, confession (C); German psalm in villages | Priest kneeling with the sexton "edder ein ander christen"; people silent | Optative by the minister (1), declaration by the priest (2) | Three Low German exhortations, one at a time; not printed by Sehling | 3.3.4, 3.5.2 |
| Brandenburg 1540 | Priest's *Confiteor* with ministrants (A) | Priest and ministrants | — (common confession forbidden) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg; after the consecration | 3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.5.5 |
| Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542 | Litany; meanwhile the priest says the *Confiteor* with the gospeller (A); a collect, perhaps *Aufer a nobis* | Priest and gospeller, privately; an open confession after the exhortation | Indicative, in the exhortation of c. 1544 (3) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg (Regensburg c. 1544); read by the gospeller after the Creed | 3.3.8, 3.5.5 |
| Schleswig-Holstein 1542 | Priest's *Confiteor* "by sick", with intercession (A) | Priest alone | — | "eine vormaninge tho dem Sacramente", not printed; when the | 3.3.2, 3.6.3 |

| Order | Opening before the Introit | Confession: who and where | Absolution (type) | Exhortation (family; place) | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | communicants have come to the altar, before the Our Father and Verba | |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 | Priest's *Confiteor* or a penitential psalm, kneeling (A) | Priest and ministrants | — (common confession forbidden) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg | 3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.5.5 |
| Wolfenbüttel 1543 | German Benedictus or psalm; Bugenhagen's prayer (B) | Priest and sexton kneeling | — | Bugenhagen | 3.3.3, 3.5.7 |
| Bergedorf 1544 | Pastor kneels at the foot of the altar for "sein gebeth" (A); German psalm or Latin Introit | Pastor alone; a form of confession recited to the people after the sermon, for teaching | — | Bugenhagen ("alse de tho Hamborgh gelesen werth"); after the sermon and hymn, before the Preface | 3.3.2, 3.5.7 |
| Hildesheim 1544 | German psalm; Bugenhagen's prayer (B) | Priest and *opperman* kneeling | — | Bugenhagen | 3.3.3, 3.6.3 |
| Amberg hospital 1544 | *Veni Sancte* by schoolmaster and boys; German collect and versicle (F) | Open confession after the sermon and general prayer | "offne absolution", not stated | Not stated; by the priest at the altar, after the litany | 3.3.7, 3.6.1 |
| Nördlingen 1544 | *Kum, heiliger Geist* or *Nun bitten wir* by two choirs (A, D, F) | Celebrant's *Confiteor*, absolved by a fellow minister; then open confession to the people | Not stated | "eine kurze vermanung", not printed (Naumburg, according to Sehling's editor); before the Sanctus | 3.3.2, 3.5.8 |
| *Cellische Ordnungen*, 1545 | Not stated (the rubrics begin with the sermon) | Private confession only | — | — ; *Aufer a nobis* sung in Latin after the sermon | 3.3.8 |
| Transylvania 1547 | German Benedictus, or the litany; *Salve festa dies* at Easter (F) | — | — | — (Creed, Preface, Our Father, Verba) | 3.3.7 |
| Amberg 1550 | Priest's *Confiteor* kneeling; choir *Haec est dies* or *Veni Sancte*; collect (A, F) | Priest; open confession after the sermon; people repeat it at weekday prayer | — | Not stated; Sehling's editor thinks it Luther's | 3.3.2, 3.4.4 |
| Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | German psalm, *Kum, hilliger Geist* on weekdays (F) | Priest at the altar's foot, during the Introit (A) | — | Bugenhagen ("Myn allerlevesten in Christo") | 3.3.2, 3.5.7 |

| Order | Opening before the Introit | Confession: who and where | Absolution (type) | Exhortation (family; place) | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg 1552 | Address, *Adiutorium*, confession (C) | Priest kneeling with another minister or the custos; choir answers; people silent | Optative by the second minister (1), declaration (2); indicative in the exhortation (3/4) | Mecklenburg; after the Sanctus, if there is time | 3.3.4, 3.4.5, 3.5.9 |
| Hohenlohe 1553 | "Das reine Confiteor lateinisch" (A) | Pastor alone, kneeling; then a common confession from the pulpit after the exhortation (from Huberinus) | Comfortable word (John 6:51) and "verkundige euch solche vergebung" (3) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg; from the pulpit after the sermon | 3.3.2, 3.5.5 |
| Regensburg 1553 | *Confiteor* (A) | Priest kneeling with the second ministrant; private confession on Saturday | Private absolution on Saturday | Brandenburg-Nürnberg (Regensburg c. 1544); read by the second minister after the Creed | 3.3.2, 3.5.5 |
| Amberg 1555 | *Veni Sancte*; *Adiutorium*; the Mecklenburg form in the plural (C) | Priest kneeling with another minister; the church silent, confessing with him | Declaration (2) | "die exhortation, so bisher gebraucht", not printed; before the Preface | 3.3.4 |
| Micron, London 1554, German 1565 (Reformed) | Bidding and prayer from the pulpit; after the sermon, the Ten Commandments and confession (E) | Minister, for the congregation | Conditional declaration (4) | Micron's own; from the pulpit after the Verba | 3.3.6, 3.5.14.4 |
| Kurpfalz 1556 | Introit, Kyrie, *Et in terra* | Open confession after the sermon on Sundays, and at the preparation before communion | Two indicative forms: "verkündige euch … solche vergebung" and "sag euch frey, ledig und loß" (3) | Württemberg 1553 | 3.4.1, 3.5.6 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 | Hymn of the Holy Ghost until the church gathers; Mecklenburg form (C, F) | As Mecklenburg 1552 | As Mecklenburg 1552 (1, 2) | Mecklenburg | 3.3.4, 3.5.9 |
| Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) | Greeting; prayer of confession before the sermon (E) | Minister; people "sprecht mit mir"; after the sermon | Conditional, with retention (4); Supper examination (5) | Palatinate; at the table | 3.3.6, 3.4.4, 3.5.10 |

| Order | Opening before the Introit | Confession: who and where | Absolution (type) | Exhortation (family; place) | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lüneburg 1564 | Introit | Private confession on Saturday after Vespers; a short form of confession read before the sermons, for teaching | Private | Osiander (Braunschweig recension), or Bugenhagen | 3.5.4, 3.5.7, 3.6.4 |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 | (see 1552) | (see 1552) | — | Its own, then Osiander (Braunschweig recension); after the Prefaces | 3.5.14.3 |
| Nürnberg, Dietrich 1569 | Introit | Appended to the exhortation | "So ir solches tut, entbind ich euch" (3/4) | Brandenburg-Nürnberg | 3.4.4, 3.5.5 |
| Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573 | German psalm; open confession in villages | Pastor; after the exhortation | Württemberg form: "verkündige euch" (3) | Württemberg 1553 | 3.5.6, 3.6.4 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 | *Nun bitten wir* or *Khom, heiliger Geist*, kneeling; Mecklenburg form (C, F) | Minister alone, kneeling | Declaration (2) | Pfalz-Veldenz's own, with the Mecklenburg prayer | 3.3.4, 3.5.11 |
| Sayn 1590 | German psalm "wann man in die Kirche kompt"; collect (F) | — | — | Mecklenburg, abridged | 3.3.7, 3.5.9, 3.6.5 |
| Marienhafe 1593 | The Supper follows the sermon and prayer; the communicants gather in the choir during *Herr Christ, du einiger Gottessohn* | Private "speciall vermanunge und absolution" beforehand; in the rite a prayer of confession in the plural, "wir arme, sundige minschen beichten", after the *Agnus Dei* | None in the rite (Sehling's editor notes its absence) | On a preaching day before; a short one on 1 Cor 11:26 after the *Agnus Dei*; its own after communion | 3.4.5, 3.5.14.5 |
| Verden 1606 | *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, *Emitte Spiritum*, *Deus qui corda* (F) | — | — | Osiander (Braunschweig recension), or Bugenhagen | 3.3.7, 3.5.4, 3.5.7 |

## 3.8 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §3.7 and the text.

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine Saxony | *Die Cellischen Ordnungen* | 1545 | 1, p. 300 | 3.3.8 |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer (Radical Reformation) | *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* | 1524 | 1, p. 499 | 3.3.8 |
| Amberg | *Ordnung der kirchen … im spital* | 1544 | 13, p. 282 | 3.3.7, 3.6.1 |
| Amberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1550 | 13, pp. 285, 286–287 | 3.3.2, 3.4.4 |
| Amberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1555 | 13, p. 290 | 3.3.4 |
| Augsburg (Moderate Reformed) | *Form und ordnung des Herren nachtmal* | 1530 | 12, pp. 40–41, 42 | 3.5.14 |
| Bergedorf | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 5, p. 387 | 3.3.2 |
| Brandenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1540 | 3, pp. 60, 65, 67–68 | 3.3.2, 3.4.6, 3.6.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach | *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften* | 1533 | 11, p. 313 | 3.6.3 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1533 | 11, pp. 188, 195–196 | 3.3.2, 3.5.5 |
| Bremen | *Eyne evangelysce Misse* | 1525 | 7/2.2, p. 405 | 3.5.14 |
| Brunswick | *Christlike ordeninge* of Johannes Bugenhagen | 1528 | 6/1, pp. 443, 443–444 | 3.4.4, 3.5.7 |
| Buxtehude | *Kirchenordnung* | 1552 | 7/1, p. 74 | 3.3.2 |
| Buxtehude | *Agende* | 1565 | 7/1, pp. 124–125 | 3.5.14 |
| Hadeln | *Kirchenordnung* | "von 1526" | 5, pp. 467–468 | 3.3.4 |
| Henneberg | *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst | 1582 | 2, p. 308 | 3.5.3 |
| Hohenlohe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1553 | 15, p. 68 | 3.3.2 |
| Lippe | *Deutsche Messe* | [c. 1525–1538] | 22, p. 565 | 3.3.4 |
| Lüneburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 6/1, pp. 544–545, 547 | 3.5.4, 3.6.4 |
| Mecklenburg | *Ordeninge der misse* | 1540/1545 | 5, pp. 150–151 | 3.3.4 |
| Mecklenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1552 | 5, pp. 197–198, 202–204 | 3.3.4, 3.5.9 |
| Memmingen (Moderate Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1528 | 12, p. 245 | 3.5.12 |
| Micron (Reformed) | *Ordinancien* (1554), German | 1565 | 7/1, pp. 631–633 | 3.5.14 |
| Moers (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1581 | 22, p. 197 | 3.5.10 |
| Nassau-Weilburg | *Agende* | 1618 | 10, p. 264 | 3.5.9 |
| Naumburg | *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St. Wenzel's | 1537 | 2, pp. 77–78, 80 | 3.3.5, 3.5.8 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Neckarbischofsheim | *Kirchenordnung* | 1560 | 16, p. 683 | 3.5.12 |
| Nördlingen | *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner | 1544 | 12, pp. 311–312 | 3.3.2 |
| Nürnberg | *Deutsche Messe* of the prior Volprecht | 1524 | 11, pp. 39–40 | 3.3.5 |
| Nürnberg | *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen* (base text of *Grundt und ursach*) | 1524 | 11, pp. 48–49 | 3.5.4 |
| Nürnberg, Andreas Döber | *Von der evangelischen meß … im Newen Spital* | 1525 | 11, p. 51 | 3.3.4 |
| Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich | *Agendbüchlein* | edition of 1569 | 11, p. 498 | 3.4.4 |
| Osnabrück (city) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1613 | 7/1, p. 269 | 3.5.7 |
| Palatinate (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1563 | 14, pp. 383, 383–386, 388, 389 | 3.3.6, 3.4.4, 3.5.10 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543 | 13, p. 70 | 3.3.2 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz | *Kirchenordnung* | 1574 | 18, pp. 498–499, 500–501 | 3.3.4, 3.5.11 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken | *Kirchenordnung* | 1557 | 18, p. 187 | 3.3.4 |
| Pomerania | *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum* | 1535 | 4, p. 349 | 3.6.3 |
| Prussia | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 4, p. 65 | 3.5.3 |
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas | 1553 | 13, pp. 419–420 | 3.3.2 |
| Schleswig-Holstein | *Deutsche Messe* (Kiel) | [after 1526] | 23, p. 55 | 3.3.4 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Die frühen Agenden* | 1525 | 20/1, pp. 158–159 | 3.5.13 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Agende* | 1537/1541 | 20/1, p. 270 | 3.3.6 |
| Transylvania | *Kirchenordnung* | 1547 | 24, p. 223 | 3.3.7 |
| Verden | *Kirchenordnung* | 1606 | 7/1, pp. 155–156 | 3.3.7 |
| Wertheim | *Kirchenordnung* | c. 1555 | 11, p. 713 | 3.5.3 |
| Wertheim | Letter of Franz Kolb to Luther | 27 August 1524 | 11, p. 707 | 3.3.6 |
| Wittenberg, Luther | *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts* | 1526 | 1, pp. 14, 15 | 3.3.7, 3.5.3 |
| Württemberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1536 | 16, pp. 107–108, 108–109 | 3.4.4, 3.5.6 |

# Chapter 4. The Propers of the Mass

This chapter follows the **propers of the Mass**, the parts that change with the day, through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. The propers covered are the introit, the prophecy or Old Testament lesson, the epistle, the gradual, the alleluia and tract, the gospel, the offertory, the Proper Preface and the communion chant. For each it asks:

- Was it **kept**, and where?
- **Who sang or read it**: the cantor and the school choir, the celebrant, the congregation, the organ? Was it sung in alternation?
- Was it in **Latin or German**?
- Were the **historic tunes** kept, cut, or replaced with new music: new tones, polyphony?

For the **Proper Prefaces** it asks also:

- On which days of the season, feast or saint were they used?
- Which Prefaces did each order have?

**Appendix 4.A** renders every Proper Preface in the corpus:

- in the original language, Latin and German or Low German;
- with a formal-equivalence translation in the idiom of the Authorized Version;
- with the list of the orders that carry each text.

Where the corpus has both the Latin and a German translation, both are given. The English is then made from the Latin, with notes on where the German shortens, adds to or changes it.

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §4.1 summarizes the findings, and §4.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §4.3 describes the three ways the orders dealt with the propers.
- §§4.4–4.9 take the propers in turn: introit, lessons, gradual, offertory, Preface, communion.
- §4.10 deals with the music.
- §4.11 is a table by order, and §4.12 a concordance.

## 4.1 Summary of findings

**1. Three models, often combined.** The orders handle the propers in one of three ways (§4.3):

- **Keep them in Latin**, sung by the school choir: the *Formula missae* line.
- **Translate them into German prose**, sung to the old tones: Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542.
- **Replace them with German hymns** sung by the congregation: the *Deutsche Messe* line.

Most territorial orders allowed all three by place and day:

- Latin "where there is a school", "in the towns", "on the feasts";
- German psalms "in the villages" and on ordinary Sundays.

The constant condition is that a proper must be **from Scripture and "pure"**. In practice this meant ***de tempore*, not *de sanctis*** (§4.3.1, §4.6.2).

**2. The introit was the most widely kept proper** (§4.4).

- **Luther's approval.** Luther approved the Sunday and festal introits "if taken from Scripture" (1523).
- **Who sang it.** The **school** sang it in Latin, under the cantor or schoolmaster, while the priest read it quietly. Villages sang a German psalm instead.

- **Fallbacks.** Where boys could not learn every Sunday's introit, they repeated *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* or *Spiritus Domini* (Hatzkerode, Heilbronn, Kurpfalz, Hamburg 1556).
- **German introits.** These appear in Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt and Hof 1592. Wittgenstein 1555 allows the festal introits to be sung in German in the villages.
- **Organ and polyphony.** By the later century the introit was often played by the organ in alternation with the choir, or sung *figuraliter* (Nördlingen 1579, Hof 1592).

**3. No Old Testament "prophecy" before the epistle survives as a regular lesson** (§4.5.1).

- **At the Mass.** The prophetic lessons that remain are the historic epistles taken from a prophet (Hof 1592). On some feasts a chapter of the feast's history is read instead (Pfalz-Neuburg 1543).
- **At the office.** Old Testament lessons belong to Matins and Vespers. They were read in the old **prophecy tone**, whose cadence is written out in solmization (Hamburg 1529, Pomerania 1535, Wittenberg 1533).

**4. The epistle and gospel of the day were kept everywhere, and read toward the people** (§4.5.2–4.5.3).

- **Exceptions.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation), and Nürnberg and Brandenburg-Nürnberg in the 1520s–30s, read whole chapters in sequence.
- **Three practices of language and tone:**
  - **German in new tones.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* has the epistle in the eighth tone and the gospel in the fifth. The Saxon orders send pastors to copy "the tone and accent customary at Wittenberg".
  - **German read without notes**, for intelligibility (Mecklenburg).
  - **Latin chanted "in the old customary melody", then read in German** (Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Hamburg 1556, Brieg 1592). Brandenburg's visitors required this in 1573.

**5. The gradual and alleluia survived as a Latin choir piece, cut short** (§4.6).

- **Cut short.** Luther limited the gradual to two verses, and kept the alleluia in Lent as "the perpetual voice of the church". Bugenhagen's northern orders cut off the jubilus, "the many notes which one was wont to hang on behind".
- **Replaced.** In villages, and where the text was "not pure", a German psalm took the place.
- **German graduals.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt have them. Nürnberg sang its gradual "in a tone made for it".

**6. The offertory chant was the proper most often dropped** (§4.7).

- **Dropped.** It went with the offertory prayers as part of the "abomination" of sacrifice (Luther 1523). Volprecht says it is "never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins".
- **Kept.** A few orders kept the Latin offertory as a Scripture text sung by the choir: Wittenberg 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Ansbach 1548, Amberg 1550.
- **Translated.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt translated it.
- **Replaced.** Most replaced it with a German psalm or the creed hymn.

**7. The Proper Preface survived chiefly on the feasts, in Latin, to the Missal tones** (§4.8).

- **Cut.** Luther cut the Preface short in 1523 and dropped it in 1526. Prussia abolished it outright.
- **The usual rule.** Most orders from Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 on adopted the rule: **the Latin Preface on the feasts, the exhortation on ordinary Sundays**.
- **The feasts.** The proper Prefaces were those of the feasts of Christ: Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity.
- **Ordinary Sundays.** Bugenhagen's northern orders chose the **Trinity Preface** "made against the Arians" (Hamburg 1529, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Herford 1532, Wittenberg 1533). Wolfenbüttel 1543 dropped even the common Preface as "needless".
- **Saints' days.** Sanctoral Prefaces were excluded as impure. The exceptions are:
  - **Michaelmas**, with the common Preface (Hoya, Osnabrück, Lippe);
  - the **Marian and Apostles' Prefaces** in Dortmund's Low German set of 1554, the Apostles' made to speak of the apostles' "doctrine";
  - Müntzer's rewording (Radical Reformation) of the Marian Preface for Advent.
- **Who sang.** The priest sang the Preface at the altar; the choir answered and sang the Sanctus.

- **Language.** In Lippe 1571 and Mecklenburg the towns had Latin and the villages German.

**8. The communion chant was optional from the start and was mostly replaced by hymns** (§4.9).

- **Optional.** Luther says "If one will sing the communion, let it be sung".
- **Kept in Latin.** Volprecht, Ansbach 1536 and Brandenburg 1540 kept it.
- **German.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and Erfurt translated it.
- **Polyphony.** In the larger churches festal motets "*sub communione*" took its place, among them Clemens non Papa's *Pascha nostrum* at Hof.

**9. The old melodies were kept, trimmed, and supplemented** (§4.10).

- **Kept.** The Latin propers kept the plainchant of the old books, standardized in **Lossius's *Psalmodia***. Rostock made it binding around 1560, and Hof used it in 1592.
- **Trimmed.** They were trimmed by verse and melisma.
- **New tones.** German texts got new or adapted tones.
- **Polyphony.** From the 1530s the feasts brought **polyphonic** introits, Masses and motets: "choraliter or figuraliter". Hof 1592 names Senfl, Lassus, Clemens, Victoria, Walter, Isaac and Josquin.
- **Organ.** The organ alternated with the choir in the introit and the ordinary.

**10. Appendix 4.A gives every Proper Preface in the corpus.**

- **Latin.** The Latin set (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity, common) belongs to the Lower Saxon and Westphalian orders, Lüneburg 1564 to Verden 1606.
- **German translations of the Latin:**
  - **Müntzer's** (1524, Radical Reformation), carried on by Erfurt, Calenberg-Göttingen and the Lippe villages;
  - **Strasbourg's** (1524, Moderate Reformed);
  - **Dortmund's** Low German (1554), which alone translates the whole Roman series, Lent, Cross, the Virgin and the Apostles included.
- **New German Prefaces.** There are four:
  - Grubenhagen's Isaiah 53 Preface for Maundy Thursday (1581);
  - Lippe's Michaelmas Preface on the forgiveness of sins (1571);
  - Kurland's Christmas and Pentecost Prefaces (1570), built on the Easter Preface.

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## 4.2 Scope, sources and cautions

**What was searched.** The `eko.db` database was searched for every proper by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *introitus*;
- *prophetia*, *lectio*;
- *epistola*;
- *graduale*, *alleluia*, *tractus*;
- *evangelium*;
- *offertorium*;
- *praefatio*, *Vorrede*;
- *communio*, *sub communione*.

It was also searched for the singers (*Schüler*, *Knaben*, *Chor*, *Cantor*, *Organist*), for the languages (*lateinisch*, *deutsch*, *düdesch*), and for the music (*Noten*, *Ton*, *tonus*, *Melodei*, *figuraliter*, *choraliter*, *mensur*). The Proper Prefaces were searched for by the opening words of each Latin text and of the known German translations. The passages were then read in context.

**Related chapters.** Two earlier chapters overlap with this one:

- Chapter 8 deals with the **hymns** that replaced the introit, gradual, sequence, offertory and communion. This chapter deals with the propers themselves: the Latin chant, German prose versions, and the lessons and Prefaces.
- Chapter 7 gives the German **common** Prefaces of the early German Masses (Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber, Bremen) and the Preface sections of Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed),

the Kiel Mass and Lippe. Those texts are cited here, not repeated, except where a Proper Preface is concerned.

Later chapters take up related subjects:

- Chapter 5 covers the collect, the secret and the postcommunion (§§5.4–5.6).
- Chapter 2 covers the place of the propers in the order of the Mass, and the Preface as part of the ordinary (§§2.5, 2.10).
- Chapter 12 covers the feasts whose propers were kept, and the proper prefaces and sequences as marks of rank (§§12.8, 12.10.3–12.10.4).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ in alternation (§9.3.3).
- Chapter 11 covers preaching on the lessons (§11.5).

**Cautions.** Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "the introit" or "the gradual", or "as hitherto", and assume the old books. Where an order is silent, the Latin chant may well have gone on.
- **Sehling did not print everything.** The edition leaves out much musical and liturgical matter. The notated Prefaces of Mecklenburg (1545, 1552), Pomerania (1542), Mansfeld (1580) and Buxtehude (1565) are described but not printed (Appendix 4.A, introduction). Hof's tables of introits and motets are printed, but its notes are not.
- **Notes are marked, not reproduced.** Where an order prints music, the edition shows "[Noten:]" and "[Ende der Noten]". The texts are given, but not the melodies. Sehling's editors often identify the melody in the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik*.
- **Town and village differ.** A territorial order often sets one practice for the towns with Latin schools and another for the villages. Both are reported here.

**Terms.**

- ***de tempore***: of the season, or of the Sunday.
- ***de sanctis***: of the saints.
- ***dominica***: of the Sunday.
- ***de festo***: of the feast.
- ***choraliter***: in plainchant.
- ***figuraliter***, ***in mensuris***, "mensur": in mensural polyphony.
- ***organicen***: the organist.
- ***Schüler***, ***Knaben***, ***Chor***: the Latin school, which was the choir.
- ***Amt***: the Mass, "the office".

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## 4.3 Three ways of handling the propers

The orders deal with the propers in one of three ways, and many combine them by place and by day:

- **keep them in Latin**, sung by the school (§4.3.1);
- **translate them into German prose**, sung to the old tones (§4.3.2);
- **replace them with German hymns** sung by the congregation (§4.3.3).

### 4.3.1 Latin propers, sung by the school (the *Formula missae* line)

**Luther's position.** Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) keeps the sung propers of the Sundays and the feasts of Christ:

- the introit (§4.4.1);
- the gradual of two verses with the alleluia (§4.6.1);
- the communion "if one will" (§4.9.1).

It rejects the offertory as the beginning of the "abomination" of the sacrifice (§4.7.1). The rule is that what is sung *de tempore*, from Scripture, may stay. Luther says the Sunday propers "alone still bear witness to the ancient purity, except the canon" (Sehling 1, p. 4).

**Wittenberg 1525.** A Wittenberg report of 1525 on "how it is held for a time with the ceremonies of the Mass" lists the parts sung. They include, at that date, even the offertory. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der messe gehalten*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 698):

> doch umb etlicher sachen umbs glauben willen lasset man singen de tempore, und nit de sanctis, und singet introitum, kyrieleison, gloria in excelsis, et in terra, collecta, oder preces, epistel, gradualia, on sequens, evangelium, credo, offertorium, prefatio, sanctus, on canonen maior und minor, dieweil die geschrift nit gemess seind.

[…] yet for certain causes touching the faith one letteth sing *de tempore*, and not *de sanctis*; and one singeth the introit, Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis, Et in terra, the collect or prayers, the epistle, the graduals (without sequence), the gospel, the Creed, the offertory, the preface, the Sanctus; without the greater and lesser canon, since these are not agreeable to Scripture.

**Who sang the Latin propers.** In the orders that kept the Latin propers, they were sung by the **school choir** under the cantor or schoolmaster: the introit, gradual, alleluia, sometimes the offertory, and the communion. The priest sang the collect, epistle, gospel and Preface. Latin was defended as **training for the boys**. Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein* (1545) has the scholars sing the introit "if it be agreeable to Scripture, or a German psalm". It adds that "where there are schools, the Latin tongue also be exercised with singing in the church". **Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 495):

> Dieweil sollen die schuler den introitum, so er der schrift gemeß ist, singen oder ein teutschen psalm, nachdem es im gebrauch ist, doch das, wo schulen sind, die lateinisch sprach auch mit dem gesang in der kirchen geübet werde.

Meanwhile shall the scholars sing the introit, if it be agreeable to scripture, or a German psalm, according as it is in use; yet so that, where there are schools, the Latin tongue be also exercised with singing in the church.

**The territorial orders.** The Latin propers were kept in this way in the territorial orders of Albertine Saxony (1539, 1580), Brandenburg (1540), Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533), Pfalz-Neuburg (1543), Mecklenburg (1545, 1552), Pomerania (1535, 1542, 1569), Hohenlohe (1553), Amberg (1550, 1555), Regensburg (1553, 1567), Hamburg (1556), Wolfenbüttel (1543, 1569), Lüneburg (1564), Hoya and Grubenhagen (1581) and Hof (1592). Each has its own limits, given in the sections that follow.

**Brandenburg 1540** is the most conservative. It keeps the Latin offertory and communion as well, in the collegiate churches and towns. The parishes and villages get German psalms (§4.7.2).

#### 4.3.2 German prose propers, sung to the old tones

**Müntzer** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (Allstedt 1524) is the first full set. For each of five offices (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Pentecost) it has a German introit with its whole psalm, Kyrie, Gloria, collect, epistle, gradual and alleluia, gospel, offertory, Preface, Sanctus, Agnus Dei and communion. It is printed with notes. Müntzer's own explanation says the people are "led with the customary singing, in their own tongue, as children are brought up with milk". **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, pp. 504–505):

> Demnach so nimpt man bei uns den eingang der geheim gotis aus dem psalter, do der schlussel David auf der schultern Christi ist, zu eröffnen alles, was gesungen wirt. Auf das man je klerlich sehe, one stückwerk, singet man den ganzen psalm, wie im anfang der christenheit durch die frommen nachfolger der heiligen aposteln geschach. […] Hirnach wirt gesungen das gradal und alleluia, auf das der mensche geherzt werd, sich festiglich auf gotis wort zuverlassen. […] Zum andern ist zu wissen, das wir alzeit ein ganz capitel anstat der epistel und evangelion lesen, auf das die stuckwerkische weise damit vorworfen werden, und das die heilige schrift der biblien dem volk gemein werde, […] und die leut mit gewonlichem gesange, mit eigener sprache geleitet werden, wie die kinder mit milch erzogen

Accordingly with us the entrance of the mystery of God is taken out of the Psalter, where the key of David is on the shoulder of Christ, to open all that is sung. That it may be seen clearly, without piecework, the whole psalm is sung, as was done in the beginning of Christendom by the godly followers of the holy apostles. […] After this the gradual and alleluia are sung, that a man may be heartened to rely firmly on God's word. […] Secondly, be it known that we always read a whole chapter instead of the epistle and gospel, that the piecemeal manner may thereby be cast off, and the holy scripture of the Bible be made common to the people, […] and the people be led with the customary singing, in their own tongue, as children are brought up with milk […]

**Erfurt and Calenberg.** The **Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt*** (1525) reprints Müntzer's offices, labels each piece (*Introitus*, *Gradual*, *Offertorium*, *Prefatio*, *Commun.*) and adds one for Trinity (Sehling 2, pp. 376–380). **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** gives a notated German Mass for the Sundays and the feasts with German epistles, gospels, alleluias and Prefaces, but it has a German psalm "in place of the offertory" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 813–833). Sehling's editors trace its Prefaces to Müntzer and to the Erfurt *Kirchenamt*.

**Strasbourg 1524** (Moderate Reformed). The **Strasbourg *Teutsche Meß*** of 1524 gives German Prefaces for the feasts (Sehling 20/1, pp. 133–134). Its Augsburg reprint explains each Latin heading for the reader: "Introitus – Das nennet man anfang oder eingang", "that is called the beginning or entrance" (p. 135). Its successors drop the Preface (§4.8.1).

**Later German prose propers.** These are fewer:

- Wittgenstein 1555 lets the festal introits be "learned and sung in German in the villages" (§4.4.4).
- Hof 1592 has German prose introits for ordinary Sundays (§4.4.4).
- The German Prefaces of Lippe 1571, Kurland 1570 and Grubenhagen 1581 are given in Appendix 4.A.

#### 4.3.3 Hymns in place of the propers (the *Deutsche Messe* line)

Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526) replaces the introit with "a spiritual song or a German psalm", and the gradual with a German hymn ("Nu bitten wir" or another). It has no offertory and no Preface. It keeps the epistle and gospel, sung in German to new tones (§4.5.3). This model, and the choice of hymns, is the subject of the hymn-practice chapter (Chapter 8, §§8.3–8.5, 8.8, 8.11, 8.14). Here it matters only as the third option, which most orders allowed side by side with the first:

- "**in the towns** Latin, **in the villages** German";
- "**where there is a school**" Latin, otherwise a German psalm;
- Latin "**on the feasts**", German on ordinary Sundays.

**Albertine Saxony.** Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 makes the arrangement for ordinary use. **Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

> sollen die schuler singen: Erstlich den introitum von der dominica, oder festen, darauf das kyrie eleison, gloria in excelsis, und et in terra latinisch, darnach die collecten deudsch oder latinisch, darauf die epistel gegen dem volk deudsch, darnach ein sequenz, oder deudschen psalm, oder andern geistlichen gesang, wie solches ein jede zeit erfordert. Darnach das evangelium von der dominica oder vom fest, auch gegen dem volk deudsch gelesen, darauf den glauben gesungen, wir gleuben all an einen gott etc.

[…] the scholars shall sing: first the introit of the Sunday or of the feast, thereafter the Kyrie eleison, Gloria in excelsis and Et in terra in Latin; thereafter the collects in German or Latin; thereafter the epistle toward the people in German; thereafter a sequence, or a German psalm, or other spiritual song, as each season requireth. Thereafter the gospel of the Sunday or of the feast, also read toward the people in German; thereupon the Creed sung, "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" etc.

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### 4.4 The introit

#### 4.4.1 Luther's rule: the Sunday and festal introits, if from Scripture

The *Formula missae* approves "the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ", Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, though Luther would rather have the whole psalms "from which they are taken, as of old". Introits of the saints may be kept by those who wish, "when they are taken from the psalms or other Scriptures". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Primo, introitus dominicales et in festis Christi, nempe paschatis, pentechostes, nativitatis, probamus et servamus, quamquam psalmos mallemus, unde sumpti sunt, ut olim, sed nunc sic usui recepto indulgebimus. Quod si qui apostolorum, virginis aliorumque sanctorum introitus (quando e psalmis aut aliis scripturis sumpti sunt) probare volent, non damnamus.

First, the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ, to wit of Easter, Pentecost and the Nativity, we approve and keep; although we had rather have the psalms, whence they are taken, as of old; but now we will indulge the received use. But if any

will approve the introits of the apostles, of the Virgin and of other saints (when they are taken out of the psalms or other scriptures), we condemn it not.

The rest of the century repeats the condition "if it be taken from Holy Scripture" or "so far as it is pure" almost word for word:

- Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 188);
- Weißenburg 1528 (11, p. 659);
- Hohenlohe 1553 (15, p. 68);
- Mecklenburg 1545 (5, p. 151);
- Teschen 1584 (3, p. 462);
- Henneberg (Meiningen) 1566 (2, p. 339).

#### 4.4.2 Who sang it: the school, in Latin, with a German psalm for the villages

**The school sang it.** The introit was sung by the **school**: the schoolmaster or cantor with the boys, "as was customary". The priest might read it quietly at the altar meanwhile. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 sets out the arrangement that became standard in the south. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

> darnach den introitum lesen, doch das er aus der heiligen schrift genummen sei. Dieweil sollen die schuler, wo man schul hat, den introitum auch singen lateinisch. Wo man aber als in dörfern zu solichem lateinischen gesang nicht leut hette, soll man ein christenlich teutsch gesang nach gelegenheit jedes orts singen. Wo aber das volk solich geseng nicht könte, sollens die pfarherr anrichten zu lernen.

[…] thereafter [let the priest] read the introit, provided it be taken out of holy scripture. Meanwhile let the scholars, where there is a school, sing the introit also in Latin. But where, as in villages, there are no folk for such Latin singing, a christian German song shall be sung, according to the occasion of each place. And where the people could not [sing] such songs, the pastors shall set about teaching them.

**Where there was no choir.** In Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, "where there is no choir, as in the country in villages", the **priest himself** sings or reads the introit (Sehling 13, p. 70).

**Saxony.** Duke Henry's Saxon order of 1539 and the Electoral Saxon order of 1580 both open the Mass with "the scholars shall sing: first the introit of the Sunday or feast" (Sehling 1, pp. 271, 368).

**The north.** The northern orders have the same division. Mecklenburg 1545 has the cantor or schoolmaster "in the towns" begin the introit in Latin, "or sing at times a German psalm". It gives the introits of the chief feasts by incipit. In the villages, between Christmas and Candlemas, the German stanzas of "Ein Kindelein so löbelich" serve as the introit. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

> Hirna schall in den steden de cantor edder scholmester den introitum anfangen to latin, effte singen under tiden enen düdeschen psalm. Erbarme di miner o here godt, etc. Menn kan dat jar aver in den steden singen de introitus, de nicht wedder de hillige schrift sint. In den hogen festen, winachte: Puer natus etc. In die Epiphanie: Ecce advenit etc. In die Purificationis singe me vor enen introitum de veer schonen versche. Ein kindelin etc. Welck ock de sondage twischen winachten und lechtmissen up den dörpern schal vor enen introitum gesungen werden. […] In den ostern: Resurrexi, Ascensionis: Viri Galilei. In den pinxsten: Spiritus domini. Trinitatis: Benedicta sit sancta tri[nitas].

Hereafter in the towns shall the cantor or schoolmaster begin the introit in Latin, or sing at times a German psalm, "Have mercy upon me, O Lord God", etc. One may through the year in the towns sing the introits that are not against holy scripture. On the high feasts, at Christmas: *Puer natus* etc. On Epiphany: *Ecce advenit* etc. On the Purification let the four goodly verses be sung for an introit, "A little child so laudable" etc.; which also on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas shall be sung in the villages for an introit. […] At Easter: *Resurrexi*; at the Ascension: *Viri Galilaei*; at Pentecost: *Spiritus Domini*; on Trinity: *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas*.

**Hesse, late in the century.** The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) allows a Latin psalm "or introit" only where there are people who understand it, and only "at the beginning, before the whole congregation cometh together". In the villages German songs only are to be sung, and in the towns German songs for the most part. **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

> ein lateinischer psalm oder introitus gesungen werden, doch daß auf den dorfen durchaus, in stedten aber mehrerteils allein teutsche gesenge im gemeinen brauch seien und bleiben.

[…] a Latin psalm or introit [may] be sung; yet so that in the villages throughout, but in the towns for the most part, only German songs be and remain in common use.

**Sung slowly.** Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 has the choir sing the introit "**right slowly, so that it become not an ass's braying**" (Sehling 6/2, p. 793).

#### 4.4.3 The Trinity or Holy Ghost introit as a fallback

Where the boys could not learn a new introit each Sunday, the orders let them repeat one. The usual choices were *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas* (Trinity) or *Spiritus Domini* (Pentecost). Hatzkerode (about 1534) allows the Trinity introit "where the Sunday introits were too hard for the boys". It adds that they "should yet learn them in time, since they are taken from Scripture". **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

> darnach den introitum von fest ader de tempore, zuweilen de S. Trinitate nach gefallen des pfarhers, wo die sontage introitus den knaben zu swer weren. Doch sollen sie die, weil sie aus der schrift genommen, mit der zeit auch lernen.

[…] thereafter the introit of the feast or of the season, sometimes of the Holy Trinity at the pastor's pleasure, where the Sunday introits were too hard for the boys. Yet they shall learn them also in time, since they are taken out of scripture.

**Other orders with the same fallback.**

- **Heilbronn's song order of 1543** begins "**Every Sunday hath its own introit, which shall be sung to the organ**". For a schoolmaster who finds that too much, it provides a reduced cycle: from Easter to Pentecost the Easter introit, from Trinity *Benedicta* (Sehling 17/1, p. 322).
- **Kurpfalz 1546** names "the introit of the season, or of the Holy Trinity, or of the Holy Ghost" (Sehling 14, p. 96).
- **Hamburg 1556** keeps the Latin introit for feasts, and "sometimes also on the Sundays *de Trinitate* or *de Spiritu sancto*" (Sehling 5, p. 552).

#### 4.4.4 German introits

**Müntzer and Erfurt.** Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (1524, Radical Reformation) and the Lutheran Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525) translate the introits into German prose, with their psalm verse and *Gloria Patri*, and sing them to the Latin melody (§4.3.2). Erfurt's Christmas introit is an example. **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525, "das ampt von der gepurt Christi"** (Sehling 2, p. 379):

> Introitus: Uns ist ein kind geboren, und ein sohn ist uns gegeben, welches hirschaft ist auf seiner schuldern. Und sein nam wurd geheissen ein engel des grossen rathes. Singet got dem herren ein neues lied; dan er hat wundersam ding gemachet. Ehre sei dem vater und dem etc.

Introit: Unto us a child is born, and unto us a son is given, whose government is upon his shoulder; and his name shall be called the angel of great counsel. Sing unto God the Lord a new song, for he hath done marvellous things. Glory be to the Father and to the, etc.

**Wittgenstein 1555.** Wittgenstein keeps the Latin festal introits, *Puer natus*, *Resurrexi* and *Spiritus Domini*. It adds that these "may also be learned and sung in German in the villages", or else replaced by the festal hymn. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

> nach dem Veni sancte den gewönlichen introitum singen, als da sind: Puer natus est nobis etc., Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum etc., Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum etc., welche man auch auff den dörffern deutsch lernen und singen kan oder an stadt derselbigen brauchen: Der tag, der ist so freudenreich etc., Christ lag in todes banden etc., Es ist das heyl uns kommen her etc.

[…] after the *Veni sancte* sing the customary introit, such as are: *Puer natus est nobis* etc., *Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum* etc., *Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum* etc.; which one may also learn and sing in German in the villages, or use in their stead: "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich" etc., "Christ lag in Todesbanden" etc., "Es ist das Heil uns kommen her" etc.

**Hof 1592.** Hof's weekly table (§4.10.3) gives German prose introits for ordinary Sundays: "Bistu, der da kommen soll?" (Advent III), "Ein kindlein ist uns geboren" (Epiphany I), "Ich bin die auferstehung" (Cantate) (Sehling 11, pp. 433–440). The festal introits are kept in Latin, in polyphony.

**Hymns in the introit's place.** These are treated in the hymn-practice chapter (Chapter 8, §8.5): "a German psalm" (Ps 67, 51, 130, 12, 124 or 14), "Komm heiliger Geist", or the feast's own *Leise*.

#### 4.4.5 Organ, polyphony and alternation

**Organ.** In the larger churches the introit was shared between organ and choir, or set in polyphony:

- In **Regensburg 1553** the organist, if there is one, "plays the introit together with the Kyrie, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus and Agnus Dei on the organ" (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- In **Merseburg 1545**, at an ordination Mass, *Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas*, the Kyrie and the Gloria were sung "on the organ and choir", in alternation (Sehling 2, p. 7).
- In **Nördlingen 1579**, on the high feasts, "the introit of the season is first struck by the organist, and sung by the scholars *figuraliter*" (Sehling 12, p. 365).

**Hof 1592** describes a three-choir alternation of the introit with the organ. The parts are the whole choir, a second choir of the older boys, and a **choir of girls**. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 424):

> I. Organicen introitum modulatur usque ad versum, chorus vero eundem gubernante ludirectore canit et quidem primam partem chorus totus, alteram seu repetitionem chorus secundus ex adulterioribus conflatus versiculum chorus puellarum, qui in ordine est tertius. His peractis organicen versiculum seu Gloria Patri praecinit; chorus totus Gloria Patri, secundus chorus denuo incipit introitum usque ad repetitionem, chorus puellarum repetitionem absolvit usque ad versiculum. […] Nota. Figuraliter eodem modo unaque vice canitur introitus praeside cantore usque ad versiculum; post organa audita versiculus additur solus nihil amplius repetito.

I. The organist playeth the introit as far as the verse; and the choir, the schoolmaster governing, singeth the same: the first part the whole choir, the second or repetition the second choir, made up of the older [boys], the versicle the choir of girls, which is the third in order. These done, the organist preludeth the versicle or *Gloria Patri*; the whole choir [sings] *Gloria Patri*; the second choir beginneth the introit again as far as the repetition; the girls' choir finisheth the repetition as far as the versicle. […] Note. In figural music the introit is sung in the same manner and once only, the cantor presiding, as far as the versicle; after the organ hath been heard, the versicle alone is added, and nothing more repeated.

Hof's festal table assigns polyphonic introits by name. For Christmas it has "*Puer natus est nobis*, a 4, by Senfl", and for the Ascension "*Viri Galilaei*, a 4" (Sehling 11, pp. 457, 462). See §4.10.

The organ's prelude and its alternation with the choir are treated in Chapter 9, §§9.3.2–9.3.3.

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## 4.5 The lessons: prophecy, epistle and gospel

#### 4.5.1 The Old Testament "prophecy"

**At the Mass.** None of the orders in the corpus adds a regular **Old Testament lesson** (*prophetia*, *lectio*) before the epistle. The lessons from the prophets that survive are of two kinds:

- **The historic epistles taken from a prophet.** Hof 1592 instructs its readers how to announce them: "Lectio ex propheta Esaia …", and the like (Sehling 11, p. 409). These are the lessons of the Christmas Masses, Epiphany and the Ember days in the Missal.
- **Festal chapters in place of the epistle.** Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has "the chapters out of the Bible" read on the feasts "wherein the history of the feast is described" (Sehling 13, p. 71). Mecklenburg 1545 reads Isaiah 40 for St John the Baptist's day, because "it is written of John the Baptist" (Sehling 5, p. 152).

**At Matins and Vespers.** The Old Testament lessons were read at the office, not the Mass. Their **tone** was the tone of the prophecies. Hamburg 1529 has the lessons read "in the tone in which one is wont to read at Matins; but the ending as one was wont to end when one read a prophecy, thus: *sol sol sol la sol fa fa*" (Sehling 5, p. 522). Pomerania 1535 prescribes the same

cadence (Sehling 4, p. 349). Wittenberg 1533 has the boys end each lesson "as one was wont to read or sing the prophecies, *in fine*: *sol sol mi fa sol sol*" (Sehling 1, p. 703). This is one of the few places where an order writes down a melodic formula of the old chant.

#### 4.5.2 The epistle and gospel: kept, and read toward the people

**Kept everywhere.** Every Lutheran order in the corpus keeps the **epistle and gospel of the day** (*de dominica*, *de festo*), with these exceptions:

- **Müntzer** (Radical Reformation) reads "always a whole chapter instead of the epistle and gospel" (§4.3.2).
- **Nürnberg 1524** and **Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533** read the New Testament continuously (*lectio continua*). In the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 the minister sings a whole chapter of Romans, and the deacon a chapter of Matthew, in German, each with a fixed announcement: "Ir aller liebsten, vernemet das N. capitel …" (Sehling 11, p. 46).

**Toward the people.** The reader turns **toward the people** ("gegen dem volk", "tom volke gekeret"). That is what made the reading a reading. The **priest** reads the epistle and gospel in most orders. Where there were deacons or chaplains, they read: in Pfalz-Neuburg and Regensburg the subdeacon and deacon (see Chapter 16, §16.4.2). Some orders read the epistle **from the pulpit**:

- Schweinfurt 1543: "the chaplain shall not read the epistle over the altar, but from the pulpit" (Sehling 11, p. 641);
- Pomerania 1535: "as one is wont to do on the pulpit" (Sehling 4, p. 341).

Preaching on the Sunday gospels and epistles is treated in Chapter 11, §11.5.1.

#### 4.5.3 Sung or read, Latin or German

**Luther's tones.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* sets the **epistle in the eighth tone**, "that it remain at the same pitch as the collect", and the **gospel in the fifth tone**, both "with the face turned to the people". **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Darnach die epistel in octavo tono, das er im unisono der collecten gleich hoch bleibe, cuius regulae sunt istae. […] Er sol aber die epistel lesen mit dem angesicht zum volk gekert, aber die collecten mit dem angesicht zum altar gekeret. […] Darnach lieset er das evangelion in quinto tono, auch mit dem angesicht zum volk gekeret.

Thereafter the epistle in the eighth tone, that he remain at the same pitch, in unison with the collect; whose rules are these: […] But he shall read the epistle with his face turned to the people, but the collects with his face turned to the altar. […] Thereafter he readeth the gospel in the fifth tone, also with his face turned to the people.

**Saxony copies Wittenberg.** The Saxon orders refer the pastors to the larger towns for the melody. The visitation instruction of 1539 says: "the melody for singing the gospels and epistles in German the pastors may seek and copy at the churches of the greater towns, as Dresden, Leipzig, Weißenfels, Salza" (Sehling 1, p. 281). Wurzen (1542) and the Saxon town orders want the epistle read "in German, in the tone and accent customary at Wittenberg, Torgau, Dresden or Leipzig" (Sehling 2, p. 98; 1, p. 564).

**Read without notes.** Other orders had the lessons read **without notes**, for intelligibility:

- Mecklenburg 1545: "with a loud voice, without notes, that the church may understand the words" (Sehling 5, p. 152);
- Mecklenburg 1552 repeats it (5, p. 202);
- Pomerania 1535: "if the priest cannot sing, he may read loud and understandable" (4, p. 341).

**Latin first, then German.** A third group kept the **Latin chant first**, for the school, and then read the lesson again in German:

- **Schwäbisch Hall** (1526): the deacon sings the gospel "in the choir in this tone, as it hath hitherto been sung", and it is then read to the people in German (Sehling 17/1, p. 40).
- **Hamburg 1556**: two scholars read the Latin gospel "in the customary tone", and a third repeats it in German "in the same tone" (Sehling 5, p. 552).
- **Brieg 1592**: the pastor sings the epistle and the gospel in Latin before the altar, but "in little towns it may remain in German" (Sehling 3, p. 445).

- **Brandenburg 1573**: the electoral visitors went furthest. They required the epistles and gospels to be sung "**not in German, but in the old customary melody in Latin**", then read in German "for the simple folk's sake, that they may understand it, which cannot happen in singing". **Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 129):

> Sie sollen auch darauf sehen, das die pfarrer und caplene die episteln und evangelia vor dem altare nicht deutsch, sondern in der alten, gewohnlichen melodei lateinisch singen, und dann hernach, um der einfeltigen willen, deutsch vorlesen, das sie es verstehen können, welches im singen nicht geschehen kan

They shall also see to it that the pastors and chaplains sing the epistles and gospels before the altar not in German, but in the old customary melody in Latin, and then afterward, for the simple folk's sake, read them in German, that they may understand it, which in singing cannot be done [...]

**Wittenberg's German tones.** Halle's order of 1543 takes the opposite view. It lets the epistles and gospels be sung in Latin "for the youth's sake", "yet it shall also be free to have them sung in German, as at Wittenberg, and especially when one hath a good melody" (Sehling 2, p. 436). **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** prints its German gospels with notes, to be sung "in German toward the people with a loud voice" (Sehling 6/2, p. 813).

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## 4.6 Gradual, alleluia and tract

#### 4.6.1 Luther: two verses, and the alleluia always

The *Formula missae* keeps "the gradual of two verses together with the alleluia, or either". The long Lenten graduals and tracts are to be sung "by whoever will, in his own house". The alleluia is not to be dropped in Lent, for "**the alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church**". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Quarto, graduale duorum versuum simul cum alleluia, vel utrum, iuxta arbitrium episcopi cantetur. Porro gradualia quadragesimalia et similia, quae duos versus excedunt, cantet quisquis velit in domo sua. In ecclesia nolumus tedio extingui spiritum fidelium. [...] Alleluia enim vox perpetua est ecclesiae, sicut perpetua est memoria passionis et victoriae eius.

Fourthly, let the gradual of two verses, together with the alleluia, or either of them, be sung at the bishop's discretion. But the Lenten graduals and the like, which exceed two verses, let whoso will sing in his own house. In the church we will not have the spirit of the faithful quenched with tedium. [...] For the alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, as the memory of his passion and victory is perpetual.

**Schleswig-Holstein and Hildesheim.** Bugenhagen's orders for Schleswig-Holstein (1542) and Hildesheim (1544) take this over. They also **shorten the melody**: the children sing the alleluia with its verse, "**but leaving out the many notes which one was wont to hang on at the end**", that is, the jubilus. Before the gradual "a German psalm, taken from Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

> Alleluia, welcker ein ewich stemme der Kercken ys, singen de kinder mit dem verse, doch uthgelaten de vele noten, de men plach hinden anthohengende, darna vor dat Gradual einen düdesschen Psalm, uth der Schrifft genamen, edder ock ein Gradual, dat men twe verse hefft.

The alleluia, which is a perpetual voice of the church, the children sing with the verse, yet leaving out the many notes which one was wont to hang on behind; thereafter, for the gradual, a German psalm taken out of Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses.

The Hildesheim text is word for word the same (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 853).

#### 4.6.2 Kept where pure, by the school, or exchanged for a German psalm

**The pattern.** The gradual and alleluia survived as a **choir piece in Latin**, sung by the school between the epistle and gospel. In the parishes and villages they were exchanged for a German psalm or hymn:

- **Brandenburg 1540**: "the gradual, or in the parishes a German psalm in place of the gradual; then the alleluia and sequence, or as occasion serveth a tract, in Latin" (Sehling 3, p. 71).
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: the choir "sings again in Latin a gradual or a tract or an alleluia with a sequence, as the order of the season giveth". "Where there is no choir, the priest may sing or say it himself, and the people meanwhile a good German spiritual song" (Sehling 13, p. 71).
- **Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533**: the priest "may read an alleluia with its verse in Latin, or a gradual taken from holy Scripture; the same the scholars may also sing in Latin" (Sehling 11, p. 195).
- **Weißenburg 1528**: "the schoolmaster sings a short alleluia or gradual" (Sehling 11, p. 659).

**Where the gradual was not pure.** The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, lists German psalms to be sung where the gradual or alleluia "were not pure, as commonly *de sanctis*". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 329):

> An den andern feirtagen und festen, die nit raine oder keine sequenz haben, sol man das gradual oder Alleluia singen. Wo aber die nit rain weren, als gemainlich de sanctis, an dero stat sing man dieser psalm einen: Ein feste burg ist unser Gott etc. Wer Gott nit mit uns diese zeit etc. Wol dem, der in Gottes forcht steht etc. Aus tiefer not etc.

On the other holy days and feasts which have no sequence, or none pure, one shall sing the gradual or alleluia. But where these were not pure, as commonly *de sanctis*, let one of these psalms be sung in their stead: "Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott" etc., "Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit" etc., "Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht" etc., "Aus tiefer Not" etc.

**The tract.** The tract, the Lenten substitute for the alleluia, appears in Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Pomerania 1569 and Hof 1592. Luther's ruling notwithstanding, these orders kept the Lenten change.

#### 4.6.3 German graduals

**Müntzer and Erfurt.** These (Müntzer's Radical Reformation offices and Erfurt's Lutheran reprint) have German prose graduals and alleluias. Erfurt's Passion gradual is an example. **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525, office of the Passion** (Sehling 2, p. 380):

> Gradual: Christus ist worden für uns gehorsam bis zum tode, zum tode des creuzes. Darumb hat in gott auch erhöhet und hat im einen namen gegeben, der uber alle namen ist. Alleluia : Alleluia. Christus ist gehorsam worden seinem vater bis in tod, und in tod des kreuzes.

Gradual: Christ became for us obedient unto death, even the death of the cross. Wherefore God also hath exalted him, and given him a name which is above every name. Alleluia: Alleluia. Christ became obedient to his Father unto death, even the death of the cross.

This is *Christus factus est*, the gradual of Maundy Thursday and Palm Sunday, in German.

**Nürnberg's new tone.** In Nürnberg, by the report sent to Goslar in 1528, "the gradual is sung, that is again a verse or two from the Psalter or another book of the Old Testament, **in a tone made for it**". The tone was new, not the old melisma (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 230).

**Calenberg-Göttingen.** The German alleluias of Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 are printed with notes. For the Purification it puts the *Nunc dimittis* hymn "Mit fried und freud ich far dahin" "for the gradual and alleluia" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 813, 823).

#### 4.6.4 The sequence

The sequence, the hymn after the alleluia, was cut back to a few "pure" texts for the chief feasts and farced with German stanzas. This is treated in Chapter 8, §8.8.2–8.8.3.

The sequences as marks of the great feasts are treated in Chapter 12, §12.10.4.

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## 4.7 The offertory

#### 4.7.1 Rejected with the offertory prayers

For Luther the offertory chant belonged to "that whole abomination" that begins at the offertory, where "almost everything soundeth and smelleth of oblation" (Sehling 1, p. 5). Most orders dropped the chant together with the offertory prayers (the *canon minor*):

- **Volprecht's Nürnberg Mass (1524)**: "The offertory is never said, **because Christ was once offered for our sins**" (Sehling 11, p. 39).
- **The Nürnberg parish Mass (1524)**: it is left out with the *canon minor* (Sehling 11, p. 47).
- **Prussia 1525**: "the offertory, secret, *canon minor* and *maior* are necessarily left out" (Sehling 4, p. 32).

**Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Prior Volprecht, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 39):

> Credo s[em]p[er] dicit[ur]. Interim praeparatur calix. Offertorium nunquam d[ici]tur, quia Christus semel pro peccatis nostris oblatus est.

The Creed is always said. Meanwhile the chalice is prepared. The offertory is never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins.

#### 4.7.2 Kept as a sung text from Scripture

**The Latin offertory kept.** A few orders kept the **Latin offertory chant** as a text from Scripture, sung by the choir while the bread and wine were prepared:

- **Wittenberg 1525** lists it among the parts sung (§4.3.1).
- **Brandenburg 1540** has "the offertory of the Sunday or feast" after the sermon, "but in the villages one may sing a German psalm for it" (Sehling 3, p. 71).
- **Amberg 1550**: "Chorus: Offertorium de tempore" (Sehling 13, p. 286).
- **The Ansbach *Auctuarium* (1548)**, an Interim order, has the schoolmaster sing "the Latin offertory **noted in the same Mass, since they are all taken from holy Scripture**", or a Latin responsory. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

> Sobald die predig ir end hat, soll der schulmaister das lateinisch offertorium, so in derselben meß verzaichnet, singen (dann sie alle aus der hailig schrift genommen) oder aber ein responsorium lateinisch

As soon as the sermon hath its end, the schoolmaster shall sing the Latin offertory that is noted in the same Mass (for they are all taken out of holy scripture), or else a Latin responsory […]

**German offertories.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* translate the offertory into German. Erfurt has an offertory for Easter ("Die erde hat erbidmet und geruget, do got wolt zum urteil auferstehn. Alleluia", *Terra tremuit*) and for Pentecost (*Confirma hoc, Deus*). In the Trinity office it has "a psalm or else a spiritual hymn of praise" "for the offertory" (Sehling 2, pp. 376–378).

#### 4.7.3 A German psalm, or the Creed, in its place

**The usual Lutheran solution.** The usual Lutheran solution was a German psalm or hymn "an stat des offertorii", sung while the elements were prepared and the communicants came forward:

- **Naumburg 1527**: "Aus tiefer Not" (Sehling 2, p. 60).
- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: "In place of the offertory one shall sing with the congregation a German psalm", and at Christmas "Ein kindelein so löbelich" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 814, 821).
- **Dortmund 1554**: "a fitting hymn of praise for the offertory" (Sehling 21, p. 209).
- **Lippe 1525**: "for the offertory one singeth a spiritual song, that is a psalm" (Sehling 22, p. 568).
- **In Bugenhagen's orders** the creed hymn "Wir glauben all" after the sermon served as the offertory (Chapter 8, §8.9.2, §8.11.3).

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### 4.8 The Proper Preface

The full texts of every Proper Preface in the corpus are in Appendix 4.A. This section deals with three questions:

- whether the Preface was kept at all;
- on which days a proper Preface was used, and which;
- who sang it, in which language and to which tune.

The Preface in the order of the Mass, required, optional or festal, is treated in Chapter 2, §2.10.1, and the proper prefaces as marks of a feast's rank in Chapter 12, §12.10.3.

#### 4.8.1 Kept, shortened or dropped

**Luther, 1523.** The *Formula missae* keeps the dialogue and the common Preface but **cuts it off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum*** and joins the Words of Institution to it. The Words are sung "in the same tone of voice" as the Preface. Volprecht and the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 follow (see Chapter 7, §7.3.2, §7.7.1). The Nürnberg Mass marks the cut with the rubric "Hic finitur prefatio" (Sehling 11, p. 47).

**Luther, 1526.** The *Deutsche Messe* drops the Preface and puts a paraphrase of the Our Father and an exhortation in its place. Orders that followed the *Deutsche Messe* closely did the same:

- The Prussian order of 1544 says plainly "In place of the preface, **which shall be abolished and left out**", the paraphrase follows. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

> An stat der prefation, welche abgethan und ausbleiben sölle, volgt balde ein offentliche vermanung und paraphrasis des vater unsers, die der priester conceptis ader prescriptis verbis thun sölle, wol laut und vernemblich

In place of the preface, which shall be done away and left out, there followeth straightway a public exhortation and paraphrase of the Our Father, which the priest shall make in conceived or in prescribed words, right loud and audibly [...]

- The Prussian order of 1568 repeats it (Sehling 4, p. 81).
- The Strasbourg agendas after 1525 (Moderate Reformed) have no Preface or Sanctus (Sehling 20/1, p. 63, editor's introduction).
- The Engerhafe liturgy in East Frisia (1583) replaces the Preface with Psalm 111 (Sehling 7/1, p. 677, n. 20).

**The compromise of 1539.** Duke Henry's Saxon order allowed the exhortation and paraphrase to be dropped "sometimes, especially on the feasts", and the Latin Preface sung instead. **Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

> Auch mag man zuzeiten, sonderlich auf die festa, die paraphrasim und vermanung dem volk furzulesen, nachlassen, und dafur die latinische prefation singen, darauf das latinische sanctus

One may also at times, especially on the feasts, forgo reading the paraphrase and exhortation to the people, and instead thereof sing the Latin preface, and thereupon the Latin Sanctus [...]

**The usual Lutheran rule.** This became the usual Lutheran rule: **Preface on feasts, exhortation on ordinary Sundays**, or Preface "if time allows". Examples:

- Hatzkerode about 1534: "on the great feasts the *praefatio de festo* shall be sung in its stead, with the customary Latin Sanctus" (Sehling 2, p. 587).
- Halberstadt: "On the high feasts the pastor singeth the preface" (Sehling 2, p. 484).
- Pomerania 1535 and 1542: "not always, but when one will, especially at the high feasts" (Sehling 4, pp. 341, 357).
- Mecklenburg 1552: "if the time allows" (Sehling 5, p. 199).
- Lüneburg 1564: "in feasts, in the towns" (Sehling 6/1, p. 546).
- Stralsund 1555: "which may also at times be left out, as the time requireth" (Sehling 4, p. 551).

**Shortened at the cantor's discretion.** Hamburg 1556 allows the Preface to be shortened, "but so that the cantor and the priest have agreed on it beforehand". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 552):

> darna de prefation latine singen na dem altar gewendet. Idt mag ock wol underwilen de prefation vorkortet werden, averst doch dat de cantor und prester des falles eines geworden vorhenne. Dat sanctus schall stedes naher gesungen werden, pro ratione festorum et dominicarum, underwilen düdesch, Jesaia dem propheten etc.

[…] thereafter sing the preface in Latin, turned to the altar. The preface may also well at times be shortened, but so that the cantor and the priest be agreed beforehand of the case. The Sanctus shall always be sung after it, according to the feasts and Sundays, sometimes in German, "Isaiah the prophet", etc.

#### 4.8.2 Which days: the temporal cycle

**The core set.** Where a proper Preface was kept, the core set was the *de tempore* Prefaces of the feasts of Christ: Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost and Trinity, with the common Preface for other days. The second Saxon visitation instruction of 1539 names exactly this set, to be taken "out of the Latin missals". **Albertine Saxony, *Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 281):

> Prefation in der messe, oder communion, prefatio in natali domini, prefatio in epiphania domini, prefatio in festo paschali, prefatio in festo ascensionis domini, prefatio in festo pentecostes, prefatio de s. trinitate. Item prefationem communem, mögen die pfarherr aus den latinischen missaln nemen

The preface in the mass, or communion: the preface on the Lord's Nativity, the preface on the Lord's Epiphany, the preface on the feast of Easter, the preface on the feast of the Lord's Ascension, the preface on the feast of Pentecost, the preface of the Holy Trinity. Item the common preface, the pastors may take out of the Latin missals […]

**Shorter sets.** Some orders used fewer:

- **Lippe 1571** prints only Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Michaelmas, for "the high four-times feasts" (*Viergezeiten*) (Sehling 21, p. 410).
- **Grubenhagen 1581** has Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Trinity, "where there are schools and boys" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1073).
- **Osnabrück 1618** has Michaelmas, Christmas, Easter and Pentecost (Sehling 7/1, pp. 268–269).
- **Kurland 1570** has German Prefaces for Christmas, Easter and Pentecost, sung "for variation" on the high feasts instead of the daily one (§4.A.14).

**Two forms for each feast.** The Pfalz-Neuburg order (in its 1547 form) says that each high feast has two Prefaces, "**a *solemnis* and a *dominicalis***". These are the solemn and the Sunday tones of the Missal. It tells the priest to write them out with their notes and keep them on the desk. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, [1547]** (Sehling 14, p. 109):

> und die prefation gantz oder ein stuck darauß nach der gelegenheyt singen oder lesen. Es seind aber auf etliche hohe fest, Osterfest, Auffart, Pfingsten, Trinitatis etc., besondere prefation, von idem fest zwo, ein solemnis und eine dominicalis, die mag ein priester außnotiren oder außschreiben und auf dem pult alwegen neben der kirchenordnung haben

[…] and sing or read the preface, whole or a piece thereof, as occasion serveth. But for certain high feasts, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity etc., there are special prefaces, of each feast two, a solemn and a Sunday one, which a priest may note out or write out and have always on the desk beside the church order […]

**Trinity on ordinary Sundays.** For ordinary Sundays the northern Bugenhagen orders chose the **Trinity Preface**, because it "was made against the Arians", "as the Nicene Creed also was". **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

> und in den groten festen, de sunderge prefation hebben, und sus wen he wil up etlike sondage mit der prefatien trinitatis, de wedder de Arrianer, alse ock das Symbolum Nicenum gemaket is, schal he anheven latinisch de prefatie dominus vobiscum und singen se bet an dat ende. Darup singe dat chor ein latinsch sanctus.

[…] and on the great feasts which have a special preface, and otherwise when he will on certain Sundays with the preface of the Trinity, which was made against the Arians, as was also the Nicene Creed, he shall begin in Latin the preface *Dominus vobiscum*, and sing it unto the end. Thereupon let the choir sing a Latin Sanctus.

**Wolfenbüttel 1543** gives the same reason, and goes further. It allows Latin Prefaces in the towns at Christmas, Easter and Pentecost, and on other feasts the Trinity Preface. Every other Preface, **the common one included**, is to be "simply let lie as unneeded". **Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge im lande Brunschwig*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 59):

> de prester mach denne ock dar wol singen de latinische praefatio vam Wynachten-, vam Paschen- und Pinxten-feste und up andere feste de prefatio de sancta trinitate, wenn man wil, welcke praefatio gemaket is wedder de Arrianer, andere praefation, ock de quotidiana, lasse men slichtes ligen alse unnödich etc. Up de latinische praefatio mach de ganze kercke frölick dat düdesch Sanctus singen.

[...] the priest may then also well sing there the Latin preface of the feast of Christmas, of Easter and of Pentecost, and on other feasts the preface of the Holy Trinity, if one will, which preface was made against the Arians; other prefaces, the *quotidiana* too, let them simply lie as needless, etc. Upon the Latin preface the whole church may joyfully sing the German Sanctus.

**Herford** (1532) has the rule that a feast takes its own Preface, and a Sunday, if any, the Trinity: "wil me ock up de sondage Prefatien holden, so schal me singen de Prefatien de Trinitate" (Sehling 21, p. 176). So does Wittenberg's own town order of 1533: "on the feasts … with the preface of the feast, or else on the Sunday with the preface *de sancta trinitate*, if one will" (Sehling 1, p. 704).

**Calenberg-Göttingen 1542** gives its model Sunday Mass a shortened German **Easter** Preface instead (§4.A.6, German 5).

**The seasons are almost absent.** No order in the corpus prescribes a Preface for **Advent** apart from Müntzer's tradition (Müntzer himself belongs to the Radical Reformation). That tradition uses the reworded Marian Preface (§4.A.10). Lent and Passiontide have a Preface only in Dortmund and in the Müntzer tradition (§4.A.4–4.A.5). Grubenhagen added a new German Passion Preface from Isaiah 53 for Maundy Thursday (§4.A.12).

#### 4.8.3 Saints' days: Michaelmas, the Virgin and the Apostles

**The purity rule.** Saints' Prefaces were generally excluded under the rule that only "pure" texts may be sung:

- Halle 1543: "at great feasts the Latin prefaces remain, **which are Christian and agreeable to Scripture**" (Sehling 2, p. 436).
- Corvinus's order for Lippe (1542): "the prefaces **that are pure**" (Sehling 21, p. 345).

The exceptions are few:

- **Michaelmas.** The common Preface is the festal Preface for Michaelmas in Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618 and Lippe 1571. Lippe's German version for the villages replaces the choirs of angels with the forgiveness of sins (§4.A.1, §4.A.13). Osnabrück sings it "on Michaelmas **and other high feasts**".
- **The Virgin and the Apostles.** Dortmund 1554 alone translates the Marian Preface, for five feasts including the Assumption, and the Preface of the Apostles. It turns the Apostles' protection into the Apostles' "doctrine" (§4.A.10–4.A.11).
- **Müntzer's tradition** (Müntzer himself Radical Reformation) keeps the Marian Preface's text but strikes Mary's feast from it, and uses it for Advent and Trinity (§4.A.10).

#### 4.8.4 Who sang it, in what language, to which tune

**The celebrant sings, the choir answers.** Everywhere the Preface belongs to the **priest at the altar**, turned to the altar (Hamburg 1556). The **choir** (the school) answers the dialogue and sings the Sanctus. Kurland 1570 and Osnabrück 1618 mark the parts "Der diener" / "Das chor" and "Minister" / "Chorus" (§4.A.14; Sehling 7/1, p. 268). In Osnabrück the Sanctus that follows "is sung or played on the organ" (Sehling 7/1, p. 269). In Wolfenbüttel 1543 "the whole church" sings a German Sanctus to the Latin Preface (above).

**Latin in the towns, German in the villages.** Language followed the school:

- Mecklenburg's Mass order of 1545 has the pastor sing the Preface in Latin or German in the towns, "in the villages German".
- It also insists on one tune: "these notes and no other", against "the useless motley singing that every man maketh after his own head". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

> mach de kerckhere singen in den steden to tiden latin edder düdesch de prefation, wo hir na folget. Up den dörperen schal men düdesch singen, unde sündergen in den festen nicht laten anstan. De trinitate ock under tiden düdesch. [...] De kerckheren willen ock düsse noten so leren, wo hirna geschreven. Unde de prefationes ock de verba consecrationis,

> mit duessen und neuen anderen noten singen. Dat unnutte bunte singent, dat ein ider na sinem koppe maket, buwet nicht in der gemene.

[…] the pastor may in the towns at times sing the preface, in Latin or in German, as here followeth. In the villages one shall sing it in German, and especially on the feasts not let it stand over. [The preface] of the Trinity also at times in German. […] The pastors will also learn these notes, as hereafter written; and sing the prefaces and also the words of consecration with these and no other notes. The useless motley singing which every man maketh after his own head edifieth not in the congregation.

- **Lippe 1571** prints each Latin Preface with a German one beside it "for the villages" (§4.A.2, §4.A.6, §4.A.8, §4.A.13).
- **Grubenhagen 1581** keeps the Latin Prefaces only "where there are schools and boys", and gives its new German Isaiah Preface "for the simple layman" (§4.A.12).
- **Kurland 1570** begins the communion "with the customary noted German preface", "since the Latin Mass is abolished" (Sehling 5, p. 89).

**The tunes.** The Latin Prefaces kept their **Missal tones**:

- Duke Henry's order of 1539 refers the pastors to "the notes of the Latin Missal". Sehling's editor gives this from the first edition (Sehling 1, p. 89).
- The 1539 instruction tells pastors to take the Prefaces "out of the Latin missals" (above).
- Amberg 1555/57 wants them sung "German or Latin, as they are in use in other evangelical places and set to the customary notes" (Sehling 13, p. 291).
- The Pfalz-Neuburg order distinguishes the solemn tone from the Sunday tone (above).
- Hof 1592 has the Preface sung on the chief feasts "from Lossius's book", that is the *Psalmodia* of Lucas Lossius (Sehling 11, p. 473).
- Sehling's editors identify the notated Prefaces of Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen and the other Lower Saxon orders with the standard melodies in the *Handbuch der deutschen evangelischen Kirchenmusik*.

The German Prefaces were sung to the same **Preface tone** adapted to German. So were the Words of Institution. Prussia 1544 has them sung "*in nota prefationis*, as they were also sung with us before in that way" (Sehling 4, p. 65).

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## 4.9 The communion chant (*communio*)

### 4.9.1 Optional, and soon replaced

**Luther.** The *Formula missae* leaves the communion chant free: "**if one will sing the communion, let it be sung**". The Agnus Dei is sung during the communion itself (Sehling 1, p. 6). **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

> VI. Deinde communicet tum sese, tum populum, interim cantetur Agnus dei. […] VII. Si communionem cantare libet, cantetur.

VI. Then let him communicate both himself and the people; meanwhile let the Agnus Dei be sung. […] VII. If it please to sing the communion, let it be sung.

**Orders that kept the Latin communio.**

- **Volprecht** (1524): "*Communio de quo sit missa*", the communion of whatever Mass is being said (Sehling 11, p. 39).
- **The Ansbach visitation order of 1536**: "where there are Latin schools", "the introit, Kyrie, Gloria, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus, Agnus Dei **and communion** in Latin" (Sehling 11, p. 326).
- **Brandenburg 1540**: "the Latin preface, the Sanctus, the communion, and further the conclusion" (Sehling 3, p. 71).

**German communio.** Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* have a German communio for each office. For Easter it is "Unser osterlamp Christus ist geopfert fur uns. Alleluia" (*Pascha nostrum*). For Christmas it is "Alle grenze der erden haben gesehn den heiland unsers gottes" (*Viderunt omnes*) (Sehling 2, pp. 376, 379). In the Advent office "a psalm or other spiritual hymn of praise" is sung "for the communion" (Sehling 2, p. 379).

**Replaced by hymns.** Elsewhere the slot was filled by the **communion hymns** and the **Agnus Dei**, often several in turn "according as the communicants be many or few". These are treated in Chapter 8, §8.14–8.15.

#### 4.9.2 Polyphonic communions and festal motets

**Motets "sub communione".** In the larger town churches the communion was covered by **motets**, Latin and German, often chosen to fit the feast:

- **Wittenberg 1533**: "*Pange lingua* in Latin and the like, and also German songs of the feast, until the communion is over" (Sehling 1, p. 705).
- **Nördlingen 1555**: on Maundy Thursday "*sub communione*, *Pange lingua* in mensural music". At Pentecost the *Sanctus paschale* may be sung "in place of 'Jesaia' and 'Jesus Christus'" (Sehling 12, pp. 321, 325).
- **Hof 1592**: the fullest list. For each Sunday and feast it names a motet "*sub communione*". For the Sunday after Easter (*Quasimodogeniti*) it gives "*Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus*, a 5, Clemens non Papa", which is the text of the Easter communio, in polyphony. "If these do not suffice, as also at other times whenever the number of communicants requireth it", it adds "Schaff in mir, Gott, ein reines Herz", a 6, by Leonhard Schröter, or *O sacrum convivium*, a 6, by Victoria. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Dominica Quasimodogeniti** (Sehling 11, pp. 461–462):

> Sub communione: Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus, A 5. Clemens Non Papa, item: Dum transisset sabbatum. Vaet. A 6. His non sufficientibus, (sicut etiam alias, quotiescunque multitudo communicantium requirit), additur Schaff in mir Gott ein reines herz. A 6. Leonhardi Schroteri, vel: O sacrum convivium. A 6. L. de Victoria.

During the communion: *Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus*, for five voices, by Clemens non Papa; also *Dum transisset sabbatum*, by Vaet, for six voices. If these suffice not (as also at other times, as often as the number of the communicants requireth it), there is added "Schaff in mir, Gott, ein reines Herz", for six voices, by Leonhard Schröter, or *O sacrum convivium*, for six voices, by L. de Victoria.

**The organ.** Several orders let the **organ** play during the communion, or alternate with the hymns:

- Regensburg 1553 (Sehling 13, p. 421);
- the Schönburg lordships (1542), "only on the high feasts" (Sehling 2, p. 171);
- Engerhafe 1583 (Sehling 7/1, p. 681).

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### 4.10 The music: old chant, cut chant, new tones, polyphony and organ

#### 4.10.1 The old melodies kept

**Latin propers.** Where the Latin propers were kept, they were sung to the **plainchant of the old books**:

- the introits, graduals and alleluias of the Gradual;
- the Prefaces in the Missal tones (§4.8.4).

The orders seldom say so outright, because it went without saying. They speak of "the customary notes", "as hitherto", "as was customary". Two late orders insist on the old melody against innovation:

- **Brandenburg 1573** requires the epistles and gospels "in the old customary melody in Latin" (§4.5.3).
- **Mecklenburg 1545** requires the Prefaces and Verba "with these and no other notes" (§4.8.4).

**The Lossius standard.** From mid-century the Latin chant was standardized for Lutheran use in **Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia*** (1553). The Rostock order of about 1560 makes it the norm for all the city's churches. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

> Es wird für gut angesehen und notig eracht, das man in allen kirchen halten sol Lucae Lossii psalmodia und sol sich das chor darnach richten. Nach dem introitum sol das kyrie gesungen und geschlahen werden.

It is held good and deemed needful that in all churches Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept, and that the choir order itself thereafter. After the introit the Kyrie shall be sung and played.

**Other references to Lossius.** Hof 1592 sings the gradual and sequence "from the great Missal or from Lossius's book", and the festal Prefaces "from Lossius's book" (Sehling 11, p. 473). On the authorized cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius see Chapter 8, §8.18.6.

#### 4.10.2 The old melodies cut

The orders also trimmed the chant:

- **Graduals:** Luther's rule of **two verses** for the gradual, with the long Lenten graduals sent home (§4.6.1).
- **The alleluia's jubilus:** Bugenhagen's **removal of the long melisma** at the end of the alleluia, "the many notes that one was wont to hang on behind" (§4.6.1).
- **Introit psalm:** Müntzer's (Radical Reformation) **whole psalm** for the introit, against the single verse of the medieval introit (§4.3.2).
- **Pace:** Calenberg-Göttingen's warning that the choir sing "right slowly, that it become not an ass's braying" (§4.4.2).

#### 4.10.3 New tones for German texts

**The new tones.** German texts needed new tones, or adaptations of the old:

- Luther's epistle tone (eighth mode) and gospel tone (fifth mode) in the *Deutsche Messe* (§4.5.3).
- The Nürnberg gradual "in a tone made for it" (§4.6.3).
- Müntzer's notated German offices (Radical Reformation), sung "with the customary singing, in their own tongue" (§4.3.2).
- The German Prefaces of Calenberg-Göttingen, Grubenhagen and Lippe, set to the Preface tone (Appendix 4.A).

**Copying the melodies.** The Saxon visitors told pastors to copy the melodies for the German epistles and gospels "at the churches of the greater towns" (§4.5.3). Halle 1543 allows the German lessons "especially when one hath a good melody" (Sehling 2, p. 436).

#### 4.10.4 Polyphony

**Feasts in mensural music.** From the 1530s the propers of the feasts were often sung **in figural (mensural) music** by the school choir. At Naumburg (1537/38) the cantor may "on the high feasts, when one singeth mensural music", sing "a good Latin motet" for the *Et in terra* or after the epistle, "and sometimes, when there is a goodly introit, the same before the 'Komm heiliger Geist'". **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71):

> an den hohen festen, wenn man mensur singet, mag der cantor wol bisweilen vor das et in terra etc. item für dem psalm, so man nach der epistel singet, eine gute lateinische muteten und bisweilen, wan ein schöner introitus ist, denselben vor das Kom heiliger geist singen.

[…] on the high feasts, when one singeth in measure, the cantor may well at times, instead of the *Et in terra* etc., and also instead of the psalm which one singeth after the epistle, sing a good Latin motet; and at times, when there is a goodly introit, the same instead of "Komm, heiliger Geist".

**"Choraliter or figuraliter".** The formula "choraliter or figuraliter" is common in the later orders:

- Gottleuba 1567: "one singeth plainchant and sometimes figural" (Sehling 1, p. 567).
- Penig 1575: "the introit, the Kyries etc., *Et in terra pax* etc. *choraliter*, oftener also *figuraliter*" (Sehling 1, p. 634).
- Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615: "an introit of the season, the Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis Deo* etc. sung in Latin, *vel choraliter, vel figuraliter*, as the season giveth occasion" (Sehling 17/1, p. 162).
- Nördlingen 1579: on the high feasts the introit is "sung by the scholars *figuraliter*" (Sehling 12, p. 365).
- Schweinfurt 1576: after the epistle the choir, "if it hath adjutants", sings "something in four or five voices" (Sehling 11, p. 648).

**Hof 1592.** Hof's *Ordo ecclesiasticus* gives the fullest repertory. For each Sunday and feast it names the polyphonic introit, Mass setting, motets after the epistle and the gospel, a motet "in place of 'Nun bitten wir'", and the motets "*sub communione*". The composers are Senfl, Lassus ("Orlandus"), Clemens non Papa, Vaet, Victoria, Johann Walter, Isaac, Josquin, Galliculus, Dressler, Meiland and others. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Christmas Day** (Sehling 11, p. 457):

> In die Nativitatis Jesu Christi. Introitus: Puer natus est nobis A 4. Senffelii. Missa super Praeter rerum seriem. A 6. Ludovici Daser. Post epistolam: Quem vidistis pastores. A 6. L. de Victoria. Post evangelium: Resonet in laudibus. A 5. Orlandi. Loco Nun bitten wir: Exultet coelum. Orlandus. A 5. Sub communione: Sanctus prioris missae.

On the day of the Nativity of Jesus Christ. Introit: *Puer natus est nobis*, for four voices, by Senfl. The Mass upon *Praeter rerum seriem*, for six voices, by Ludwig Daser. After the epistle: *Quem vidistis pastores*, for six voices, by L. de Victoria. After the gospel: *Resonet in laudibus*, for five voices, by Orlando. In place of "Nun bitten wir": *Exultet coelum*, by Orlando, for five voices. During the communion: the Sanctus of the foregoing Mass.

**The plain Sundays at Hof.** Beside this, Hof's ordinary Sunday table uses **German** introits and chorale Kyries (§4.4.4). The festal Latin polyphony and the German chorale service stand side by side in the same order.

**Rhau's collections.** Sehling's editors note that Georg Rhau's printed collections of 1539–1545 supplied Lutheran choirs with polyphonic introits, alleluias and sequences (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085).

#### 4.10.5 The organ

**Organ and choir.** The organ entered the propers in alternation with the choir:

- **Heilbronn 1543**: "every Sunday hath its own introit, which shall be sung **to the organ**" (Sehling 17/1, p. 322).
- **Regensburg 1553**: the organist "plays the introit" with the ordinary (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- **Schweinfurt 1576**: the organist begins the introit "which the choir singeth after" (Sehling 11, p. 648).
- **Hof 1592**: the organ plays the introit "as far as the verse" in alternation with three choirs (§4.4.5).
- **Osnabrück 1618**: the Sanctus after the Preface "is sung or played on the organ" (Sehling 7/1, p. 269).

**Silent seasons.** Hof stops the organ from Advent II until Christmas Eve (Sehling 11, p. 432).

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### 4.11 Table by order

**Key.**

- **L**: Latin, sung by the school or choir.
- **G**: German prose proper.
- **H**: German hymn or psalm in its place.
- **—**: dropped.
- **?**: not stated.
- "town / village": the order sets different practice.

| Order | Vol. | Introit | Epistle and gospel | Gradual, alleluia | Offertory | Preface | Communio | Music |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1 | L (Sunday and festal, from Scripture) | L | L (two verses); alleluia always | — | Common, cut at *per Christum* | L "if one will" | Plainchant |
| Müntzer, Allstedt, 1524 (Radical Reformation) | 1 | G (whole psalm) | G, whole chapters | G | G | G (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Pentecost) | G | Notated; "customary singing in own tongue" |
| Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524 | 11 | L | G, chapters in sequence | L | — | Common, cut | ? | Plainchant |
| Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524 | 11 | L | ? | L | — ("never said") | Common, cut | L (*de quo sit missa*) | — |
| Wittenberg report, 1525 | 1 | L | L | L (no sequence) | L | L | ? | — |

| Order | Vol. | Introit | Epistle and gospel | Gradual, alleluia | Offertory | Preface | Communio | Music |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525 | 2 | G | G | G | G (Easter, Pentecost); H (Trinity) | G (Müntzer's, plus Trinity) | G; H (Advent) | Notated |
| Strasbourg *Teutsche Meß*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | ? | G | ? | ? | G (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost; Cross in Schwarz) | ? | — |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | H | G (8th and 5th tones) | H | — | — | H | New tones |
| Nürnberg report for Goslar, 1528 | 7/2.2 | L | G (levites) | gradual "in a tone made for it" | — | Common, cut | ? | New tone |
| Hamburg, 1529 | 5 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L on feasts; Trinity on Sundays | ? | Prophecy cadence written out |
| Herford, 1532 | 21 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L on feasts; Trinity on Sundays | ? | — |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533 | 11 | L by school / H in villages | G, chapters in sequence | L | — | — | ? | — |
| Wittenberg town order, 1533 | 1 | ? | ? | L alleluia, at times gradual | ? | Feast Preface; Trinity on Sundays | Motets (*Pange lingua*) | Prophecy cadence |
| Hatzkerode, 1534(?) | 2 | L; Trinity as fallback | G | ? | ? | L on great feasts | ? | Organ in Kyrie and Gloria |
| Pomerania, 1535/1542/1569 | 4 | L / H | Epistle tone or read | L where schools; tract | ? | L or G on feasts (16 Prefaces, 1542, not printed) | ? | Prophecy cadence |
| Naumburg St Wenzel, 1537/38 | 2 | L "goodly introit" on feasts | ? | H | H ("Aus tiefer Not", 1527) | ? | ? | Mensural motets on high feasts |
| Albertine Saxony (Duke Henry), 1539 | 1 | L by scholars | G toward the people | H or sequence | — | L on feasts instead of exhortation | ? | Missal notes; Wittenberg tones |

| Order | Vol. | Introit | Epistle and gospel | Gradual, alleluia | Offertory | Preface | Communio | Music |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg, 1540 | 3 | L | L in foundations / G in parishes | L / H in parishes; tract | L / H in villages | L (common) | L | — |
| Schleswig-Holstein, 1542; Hildesheim, 1544 | 23; 7/2.1 | ? | G | Alleluia with verse, jubilus cut; gradual of two verses / H | Creed hymn | L Prefaces at feasts | H | Melisma cut |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542 | 6/2 | L ("slowly") | G sung, notated | G alleluia, notated | H | G (Müntzer's; Sunday Easter form) | H | Notated |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543 (1547 edn.) | 13; 14 | L / priest in villages | G; festal chapters | L / priest | Offertory prayer (Osiander) | Solemn and Sunday forms for each feast | ? | Two Preface tones |
| Wolfenbüttel, 1543 | 6/1 | L on feasts of Christ | ? | ? | Creed hymn | L Christmas, Easter, Pentecost; Trinity; not the common | H | German Sanctus by the whole church |
| Heilbronn song order, 1543 | 17/1 | L to the organ; reduced cycle | ? | L alleluia or gradual | ? | ? | ? | Organ alternation |
| Mecklenburg, 1545/1552 | 5 | L in towns, listed by feast / H in villages | G read "without notes" | H | ? | L or G in towns / G in villages (not printed) | ? | "These notes and no other" |
| Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, 1545 | 11 | L where schools / H | ? | L or H | — | — | ? | Latin "exercised" for the schools |
| Ansbach visitation, 1536; *Auctuarium*, 1548 | 11 | L | ? | L where pure / H | L (from Scripture) | ? | L | — |
| Amberg, 1550/1555 | 13 | L | Customary tone | ? | L *de tempore* | L or G on feasts, "customary notes" | ? | — |

| Order | Vol. | Introit | Epistle and gospel | Gradual, alleluia | Offertory | Preface | Communio | Music |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Regensburg, 1553 | 13 | L / organ | G | L or Latin text from the gradual | — | — | Organ with hymns | Organ |
| Dortmund, 1554 | 21 | ? | Read or sung, "after old custom" | H | H | Full Roman set in Low German | ? | — |
| Wittgenstein, 1555 | 22 | L festal / G in villages | ? | ? | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Hamburg, 1556 | 5 | L on feasts; Trinity or Holy Ghost on Sundays | L read by scholars, then G | ? | ? | L, may be shortened by agreement with the cantor | ? | — |
| Lüneburg, 1564 | 6/1 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L set (7) on high feasts, in towns | ? | Notated |
| Wolfenbüttel, 1569 | 6/1 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L set (7) | ? | Notated |
| Kurland, 1570 | 5 | ? | ? | ? | ? | G "customary noted" daily; G festal (3) | ? | Notated |
| Lippe, 1571 | 21 | L on feasts of Christ | ? | ? | ? | L in towns / G in villages: Christmas, Easter, Pentecost, Michaelmas | ? | Notated |
| Brandenburg visitation, 1573 | 3 | ? | **L "old melody", then G read** | ? | ? | ? | ? | Old melody required |
| Hesse *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8 | L only before the people gather; H | ? | ? | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Nördlingen, 1579 | 12 | Organ plus scholars *figuraliter* on feasts; | ? | ? | ? | ? | ? | Polyphony, organ |

| Order | Vol. | Introit | Epistle and gospel | Gradual, alleluia | Offertory | Preface | Communio | Music |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | H on Sundays | | | | | | |
| Grubenhagen, 1581; Hoya, 1581 | 6/2 | L (Hoya: pastor) | ? | ? | ? | L where schools; Michaelmas (Hoya); German Isaiah 53 Preface (Grubenhagen) | ? | Notated |
| Hof, 1592 | 11 | L figural on feasts / G on Sundays; organ and three choirs | L then G | L from the Missal or Lossius; tract | ? | L from Lossius on chief feasts | Motets | Senfl, Lassus, Clemens, Victoria |
| Brieg, 1592 | 3 | L | L sung / G in small towns | L | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Verden, 1606 | 7/1 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L set (7) | ? | Notated |
| Osnabrück, (1588) 1618 | 7/1 | ? | ? | ? | ? | L: Michaelmas, Christmas, Easter, Pentecost | ? | Sanctus by organ |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615 | 17/1 | L *choraliter vel figuraliter* | G (1526: L sung, then G) | L | ? | ? | ? | Polyphony |

## 4.12 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited ("A" = Appendix 4.A).

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523 | 1, pp. 4–6 | 2 | 4.3.1, 4.4.1, 4.6.1, 4.7.1, 4.8.1, 4.9.1, 4.A.1 |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524 (Radical Reformation) | 1, pp. 500–504 | 51, 52 | 4.3.2, 4.A.2, 4.A.5, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.10 |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation) | 1, pp. 504–505 | 52 | 4.3.2, 4.5.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der messe gehalten*, 1525 | 1, p. 698 | 147 | 4.3.1, 4.7.2 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, p. 14 | 3 | 4.3.3, 4.5.3 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533 | 1, pp. 703–705 | 148 | 4.5.1, 4.8.2, 4.9.2 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry's *Agende*), 1539 | 1, pp. 89 (editor), 271 | 7, 30 | 4.3.3, 4.4.2, 4.8.1, 4.8.4 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Instruktion zur zweiten Visitation*, 1539 | 1, p. 281 | 31 | 4.5.3, 4.8.2, 4.8.4 |
| Gnandstein, visitation articles, 1539 | 1, p. 564 | 85 | 4.5.3 |
| Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542 | 2, p. 98 | 1223 | 4.5.3 |
| Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung*, 1567–1577 | 1, p. 567 | 87 | 4.10.4 |
| Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 1, p. 634 | 116 | 4.10.4 |
| Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580 | 1, p. 368 | 44 | 4.4.2 |
| Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525 | 2, pp. 376–380 | 1251 | 4.3.2, 4.4.4, 4.6.3, 4.7.2, 4.9.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.5, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.10 |
| Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1527, 1537/1538 | 2, pp. 60, 71 | 1218, 1219 | 4.7.3, 4.10.4 |
| Merseburg, ordination Mass, 1545 | 2, p. 7 | 1210 | 4.4.5 |
| Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Halle*, 1543 | 2, p. 436 | 1257 | 4.5.3, 4.8.3, 4.10.3 |
| Halberstadt, town order | 2, p. 484 | 1260 | 4.8.1 |
| Hatzkerode (Anhalt), *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?) | 2, pp. 586–587 | 1263 | 4.4.3, 4.8.1 |
| Schönburg lordships, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542 | 2, p. 171 | 1235 | 4.9.2 |
| Henneberg, Meiningen, 1566 | 2, p. 339 | 1248 | 4.4.1 |

**Brandenburg, Pomerania, Prussia and the Baltic**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, p. 71 | 1746 | 4.3.1, 4.6.2, 4.7.2, 4.9.1 |
| Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573 | 3, p. 129 | 1748 | 4.5.3, 4.10.1 |
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592 | 3, p. 445 | 1809 | 4.5.3 |
| Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584 | 3, p. 462 | 1815 | 4.4.1 |
| Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525 | 4, p. 32 | 1832 | 4.7.1 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544; *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, pp. 65, 81 | 1833 | 4.8.1, 4.8.4 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535; *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535 | 4, pp. 341, 349 | 1856, 1857 | 4.5.1, 4.5.2, 4.5.3, 4.8.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 4, pp. 357, 370 | 1859 | 4.8.1, 4.A |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4, p. 438 | 1865 | 4.6.2 |
| Stralsund, *Entwurf einer Kirchenordnung*, 1555 | 4, p. 551 | 1889 | 4.8.1 |
| Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, pp. 89–90 | 1907 | 4.8.2, 4.8.4, 4.A.6, 4.A.14, 4.A.15 |
| Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 | 5, pp. 151–154 | 1922 | 4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.5.1, 4.5.3, 4.8.4, 4.10.1 |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, pp. 199, 202 | 1922 | 4.5.3, 4.8.1, 4.A |
| Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, 1560–1576 | 5, p. 288 | 1936 | 4.10.1 |
| Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 522, 528 | 1960 | 4.5.1, 4.8.2 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 552 | 1963 | 4.4.3, 4.5.3, 4.8.1, 4.8.4 |

**Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the north**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543 | 6/1, p. 59 | 1972 | 4.8.2, 4.8.4 |
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 180–181 | 1974 | 4.A.1–4.A.9 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 546, 574–575 | 2003, 2005 | 4.8.1, 4.A.1–4.A.9 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, pp. 793–833 | 2036, 2037 | 4.3.2, 4.4.2, 4.5.3, 4.6.3, 4.7.3, 4.8.2, 4.A.2, 4.A.5–4.A.8, 4.A.10 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1073–1074 | 2058 | 4.8.2, 4.8.4, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.9, 4.A.12 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1154–1155 | 2065 | 4.8.3, 4.A.1–4.A.2, 4.A.6–4.A.9 |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, pp. 206–207 | 2092 | 4.A.1–4.A.9 |
| Osnabrück, *Agende* (1588) 1618 | 7/1, pp. 268–269 | 2100 | 4.8.2, 4.8.3, 4.8.4, 4.10.5, 4.A.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8 |
| Engerhafe (East Frisia), *Liturgie*, 1583 | 7/1, pp. 677, 681 | 2119 | 4.8.1, 4.9.2 |
| Nürnberg, *Bericht für den Goslarer Rat*, 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 230 | 2186 | 4.6.3, 4.10.3 |
| Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 7/2.1, pp. 853, 855 | 2136 | 4.6.1, 4.A |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (editors' notes) | 7/2.1, p. 1085 | 2149 | 4.10.4 |
| Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 21, p. 176 | 1442 | 4.8.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554 | 21, pp. 209–211 | 1446 | 4.7.3, 4.8.3, 4.A.1–4.A.11 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus, 1542 | 21, p. 345 | 1460 | 4.8.3 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 410–411 | 1462 | 4.8.2, 4.8.3, 4.8.4, 4.A.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.6, 4.A.8, 4.A.13 |
| Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538] | 22, p. 568 | 1549 | 4.7.3, 4.A.9 |
| Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1555 | 22, p. 102 | 1493 | 4.3.2, 4.4.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, p. 90 | 1576 | 4.6.1 |
| Kiel, Low German Mass, [after 1526] | 23, p. 56 | 1576 | 4.A.6 |

**Hesse**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8, p. 411 | 2272 | 4.4.2 |

**Franconia, Bavaria, the Palatinates and Swabia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe* of Prior Volprecht, 1524 | 11, p. 39 | 247 | 4.7.1, 4.9.1 |
| Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524 | 11, pp. 46–47 | 249 | 4.5.2, 4.7.1, 4.8.1 |
| Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 11, p. 659 | 308 | 4.4.1, 4.6.2 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, pp. 188, 195 | 270 | 4.4.1, 4.4.2, 4.6.2 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Kirchenvisitation*, 1536 | 11, p. 326 | 277 | 4.9.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order) | 11, pp. 329–330 | 278 | 4.6.2, 4.7.2 |
| Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545 | 11, p. 495 | 297 | 4.3.1 |
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543; *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576 | 11, pp. 641, 648 | 304, 305 | 4.5.2, 4.10.4, 4.10.5 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 409, 424, 432–473 | 294 | 4.4.4, 4.4.5, 4.5.1, 4.6.2, 4.8.4, 4.9.2, 4.10.1, 4.10.4, 4.10.5 |
| Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1555 | 12, pp. 321, 325 | 373 | 4.9.2 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579 | 12, p. 365 | 375 | 4.4.5, 4.10.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, pp. 70–71 | 386 | 4.4.2, 4.5.1, 4.6.2 |
| Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550; 1555/1557 | 13, pp. 286, 291 | 411, 412 | 4.7.2, 4.8.4 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553 | 13, p. 421 | 440 | 4.4.5, 4.9.2, 4.10.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546 | 14, p. 96 | 472 | 4.4.3 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, [1547] | 14, p. 109 | 473 | 4.8.2, 4.8.4 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15, p. 68 | 539 | 4.4.1 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Frühmessordnung*, 1526 | 17/1, p. 40 | 754 | 4.5.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615 | 17/1, p. 162 | 762 | 4.10.4 |
| Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543 | 17/1, p. 322 | 782 | 4.4.3, 4.10.5 |

**Alsace**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, Mass of Diebold Schwarz, and *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, pp. 121, 133–135 | 1279 | 4.3.2, 4.8.1, 4.A.2, 4.A.3, 4.A.5–4.A.8 |

## Appendix 4.A The Proper Prefaces: texts and translations

This appendix gives every Proper Preface printed in the corpus, once for each distinct text, and lists the orders that carry it.

**How the entries are laid out.**

- **The Latin, where the corpus has it.** The Latin text is given first, from one witness, with the other witnesses listed and their variants noted. The English is translated from the Latin.
- **The German translations.** Each distinct German or Low German translation follows, with notes on where it shortens, adds to or changes the Latin.
- **German where the Latin is not in the corpus.** Some prefaces survive only in German: Lent, the Cross, the Blessed Virgin and the Apostles. The Latin of these is not printed anywhere in the corpus, so the English is made from the German. The note names the Latin preface of the Roman Missal that the German renders.
- **New German compositions.** Prefaces that are new German texts, not translations, are given last (§4.A.13–4.A.16).

**Where the Latin set comes from.** The Latin texts all belong to one Lower Saxon and Westphalian chain of orders:

- Lüneburg 1564;
- Wolfenbüttel 1569;
- Grubenhagen and Hoya 1581;
- Verden 1606;
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618;
- Lippe 1571.

These orders print the prefaces "with notes" at the end of the order or of the Mass. Sehling's editors refer them to the Roman Missal (*Röm. Meßbuch*) and to the *Missale Hildensemense* of 1511 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855, n. 33).

**Prefaces mentioned but not printed.** Several orders printed prefaces that Sehling's edition does not reproduce:

- Mecklenburg 1540/45 ("Folgen Präfationes, 35 Seiten, mit Noten");
- Mecklenburg 1552;
- Pomerania 1542 ("Folgen 16 praefationes mit Noten");
- Mansfeld 1580 ("eine Reihe von Präfationes");
- Buxtehude 1565, which has Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost, Trinity and the *Quotidiana*;
- Oldenburg 1573.

Their texts are not in the corpus. Where their headings are given, they match the Lower Saxon set.

**Already in Chapter 7.** The *common* Preface in German is also rendered in Chapter 7, for Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber and Bremen. Those renderings are not repeated here.

### 4.A.1 The dialogue and the common Preface (*Quotidiana*, *Praefatio communis*)

The common Preface frames every proper one. After *Vere dignum … aeterne Deus* the proper text is inserted, and it ends with its own *Et ideo* or *Per quem* clause. In the Lower Saxon orders the common Preface is also the festal Preface of **Michaelmas** (29 September) in Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618 and Lippe 1571. This is the only sanctoral use of a Latin Preface in the corpus (§4.8.3).

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (Sehling 6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 180);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 206);
- Hoya 1581, "In die Michaelis" (6/2, p. 1155);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618, "In die Michaelis" (7/1, pp. 268–269);
- Lippe 1571, "In die Michaelis" (21, p. 411).

Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) and the Nürnberg parish Mass of 1524 keep only the opening, cut off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* (§4.8.1).

**Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569, "Quotidiana"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 180):

> Dominus vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo. Sursum corda. Habemus ad Dominum. Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro. Dignum et iustum est. Vere dignum et iustum est, aequum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere, Domine sancte Pater omnipotens, aeterne Deus, per Christum Dominum nostrum, per quem maiestatem tuam laudant angeli, adorant dominationes, tremunt potestates, coeli coelorumque virtutes ac beata seraphin socia exultatione concelebrant. Cum quibus et nostras voces ut admitti iubeas te precamur supplici confessione dicentes:

The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Lift up your hearts. We lift them up unto the Lord. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is meet and right. It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O holy Lord, Father almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord; through whom the Angels praise thy majesty, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble, the heavens and the Virtues of the heavens and the blessed Seraphim with one accord celebrate it with exultation. With whom we beseech thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted, saying with lowly confession:

The German versions of the common Preface follow the Latin closely. The Low German of **Dortmund 1554** is a fair example. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Gemen edder Dechlike Prefatio"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

> Ja frylick (warlick) isset recht unde billick, behörlick unde ock heilsam, Dat wy dy, Here, O hilge Vader, Almechtige, ewige Godt, tho allen tyden unde steden dancken Dorch Christum, unsen Heren, Dorch welcken dyne Herlicheit de Engele laven, de herschopen anbeden, de Mechte fruchten. Dartho ock de Hemmele unde der hemmelen Krefften unde de hilligen Seraphim mit groter froude tho samen hochlick eeren unde prysen, Mit welcken wy bidden, du willest tholaten, unse stemme demötlick loffsingende (loffsegende).

*Notes on the German.*

- The Low German doubles some terms: "recht unde billick, behörlick unde ock heilsam" for *dignum et iustum, aequum et salutare*.
- *Supplici confessione* becomes "humbly singing praise" (or "speaking praise"). The printed alternatives in brackets are the order's own.

Dortmund also gives the short form that Luther had made. It runs "through Christ our Lord, who in the night when he was betrayed took the bread" straight into the Words of Institution (Sehling 21, pp. 209–210).

#### 4.A.2 Christmas (*Quia per incarnati Verbi mysterium*)

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 180);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1073; reads *infulsit*, the Missal's reading, for *effulsit*);

- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1154; *agnoscimus* for *cognoscimus*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 206);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269; *caritatis* for *claritatis*);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 410).

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "In die nativitatis Christi"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

> Vere dignum et etc. Aeterne Deus, quia per incarnati verbi mysterium nova mentis nostrae oculis lux tuae claritatis effulsit, ut dum visibiliter Deum cognoscimus, per hunc in invisibilium amorem rapiamur. Et ideo cum angelis et archangelis, cum thronis et dominationibus, cumque omni militia coelestis exercitus hymnum gloriae tuae canimus, sine fine dicentes.

It is very meet, etc. … everlasting God: for by the mystery of the Word made flesh the new light of thy brightness hath shone upon the eyes of our mind; that while we know God visibly, we may by him be caught up into the love of things invisible. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

**German (1): Müntzer's translation** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* (1524) has this translation. So do the Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* (1525; Sehling 2, p. 379), Calenberg-Göttingen (1542; 6/2, p. 821) and Lippe 1571, "auff den Dörffern an Weihenachten" (21, p. 410). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, Christmas office** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, pp. 501–502):

> Dann durch das geheimnis des vormenschten wortes ist das neue licht deiner klarheit den augen unsers gemüthes erschinen. Auf das so wir got sichtbarlich erkennen, mügen kummen zu dem erkentnis der unsichbaren gotheit. Dorumb singen wir mit allen engeln und erzengein, und mit den, do got innen hirschet, dozu mit aller himlischer geselschaft, singen wir eine leisen deinem preise one ende sagende.

*Notes on Müntzer's German.*

- **Opening.** It begins at *quia*. The opening is "as in the Mass of Advent" (§4.A.11).
- ***Per hunc in invisibilium amorem rapiamur*** ("may by him be caught up into the love of things invisible") becomes "may come to the knowledge of the invisible Godhead". The words "by him" are dropped, and love becomes knowledge.
- ***Cum thronis et dominationibus*** becomes "with them in whom God reigneth": the Thrones are read as the seat of God.
- ***Omni militia coelestis exercitus*** becomes "all the heavenly company".
- ***Hymnum gloriae tuae canimus*** becomes "sing we a *Leise* to thy praise". A *Leise* is a vernacular hymn ending *Kyrieleis*.
- **Lippe 1571** substitutes "Lobgesang deines preyses", "a song of praise of thy glory", for *eine leisen*.

**German (2): Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Etliche vorreden"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

> So du in der oben angezeigten Prefation gelesen hast das wörtlin Ewiger Gott, so folget: Dann durch die geheymnuß des worts, so fleysch worden, ist ein neüwes liecht deiner klarheit den augen unsers gemüts erschinen, auff das, so wir Gott sichtbarlichen erkennen, das wir durch in zuor liebe unsichtbarer dingen gezogen werden, Deßhalb wir mit den Engeln und allen hymmlischen härscharen dir singen on underlaß den preyß deiner ere und sagent:

When thou hast read in the Preface shewn above the little word "everlasting God", there followeth: For by the mystery of the Word which was made flesh a new light of thy brightness hath appeared to the eyes of our mind; that, as we know God visibly, we may by him be drawn to the love of invisible things. Wherefore we with the Angels and all the heavenly hosts sing unto thee without ceasing the praise of thine honour, and say:

*Notes on the Strasbourg German.*

- This is a close translation, and it keeps *per hunc* ("durch in") and *amorem* ("liebe").
- It drops the Archangels, Thrones and Dominions.
- It renders *sine fine* "without ceasing".
- The rubric shows that the proper text was spliced into the common Preface after *aeterne Deus*, as in the Missal.

**German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Vorrede tho Wynachten edder Midtwynter"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> Wente dorch de geheimniss des fleschgewordenen Wordes (edder: went dorch de minschwerdinge dynes leven Söns) ys unses herten ogen ein nye licht dyner klarheit erschenen, Up dat, als wy Godt sichtlick erkennen, dorch em thor leve der unsichtliken dinge getagen werden, Darumme mit den Engelen unde Ertzengelen, mit den Thronen unde den Herschopen Unde ock mit aller Ridderschop des Hemmelschen heres singen wy loff dyner herlicheit, sunder ende seggende: Hillich etc.

*Notes on the Dortmund Low German.*

- This is a full and faithful translation, with every rank of angel kept.
- It offers an alternative, "by the incarnation of thy dear Son", for "the mystery of the Word made flesh".
- It renders *mentis* as "heart".

#### 4.A.3 Epiphany (*Quia cum Unigenitus tuus*)

**Latin witnesses:** Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574), Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, pp. 180–181) and Verden 1606 (7/1, pp. 206–207). Grubenhagen, Hoya, Osnabrück and Lippe have no Epiphany Preface.

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "In die epiphanias"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

> Vere dignum et iustum etc. Aeterne Deus, qui cum unigenitus tuus in substantia nostrae mortalitatis apparuit, nova nos immortalitatis suae luce reparavit, et ideo cum angelis et archangelis, cum thronis et dominationibus, cumque omni militia coelestis exercitus hymnum gloriae tuae canimus, sine fine dicentes.

It is very meet and right, etc. … everlasting God: for when thine Only-begotten appeared in the substance of our mortality, he restored us by the new light of his immortality. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

*Note.* The Lower Saxon orders print *qui cum* where the Missal has *quia cum*.

**German: Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Ein ander Vorred"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

> Ewiger Gott, So dein eingeborner sun in dem wesen unser tödtlicheit erschinen ist, hat er uns mit dem neüwen liecht seiner untödtlichheyt widerbracht etc., Deshalb wir etc., wie oben steet.

Everlasting God, when thine only-begotten Son appeared in the being of our mortality, he restored us with the new light of his immortality, etc.; wherefore we, etc., as standeth above.

*Note.* The translation is exact; *substantia* becomes "wesen", "being".

**German: Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Inn der Apenbaringe Christi edder der Köninge dach"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> Wente do dyn eingebaren Söne yn gestalt (edder: yn der Substantien efft wesende) unser sterfflicheit ys erschennen, hefft he uns mit dem nyen lichte syner unsterfflicheit wedder maket. Darumme etc., wo baven.

For when thine only-begotten Son appeared in the form (or: in the substance or being) of our mortality, he made us anew with the new light of his immortality. Therefore, etc., as above.

#### 4.A.4 Lent (*Qui corporali ieiunio*)

**Witness:** Dortmund 1554 only. No Latin Lenten Preface is printed in the corpus. The Low German renders the Missal's *Qui corporali ieiunio vitia comprimis, mentem elevas, virtutem largiris et praemia*, faithfully. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Inn der Vasten"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> De du dorch dat lyfflike vastent de gebrecke vordrückest, dat herte erhevest, dogede unde lon uns gevest Dorch Christum, unsen Heren, Dorch welcken etc., wo nedden yn der gemenen vorrede.

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who by bodily fasting dost suppress our faults, lift up the heart, and give us virtue and reward; through Christ our Lord, through whom, etc., as below in the common Preface.

#### 4.A.5 Passiontide and the Holy Cross (*Qui salutem humani generis in ligno crucis*)

**Witnesses:** Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation; 1, p. 502), Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 380), Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 826), Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed; 20/1, p. 121) and Dortmund 1554 (21, p. 210).

- Müntzer, Erfurt and Calenberg use it in the Mass "of the suffering of Christ".
- Strasbourg puts it in its ordinary Sunday Mass.
- Dortmund uses it "of the Cross and Passion of Christ".

No Latin text of this Preface is printed in the corpus. The German renders the Missal's *Qui salutem humani generis in ligno crucis constituisti, ut unde mors oriebatur, inde vita resurgeret, et qui in ligno vincebat, in ligno quoque vinceretur*.

**German (1): Müntzer** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's translation is also in Erfurt and Calenberg. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Passion** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 502):

> Warlich es ist wirdig und recht billich und ist heilsam, das wir dir herr almechtiger ewiger got allzeit danksagen. Der du das heil des menschlichen geschlechtes am holz des kreuzes dargestelt hast, auf das do der tod her entsprossen war, solt wider erstehn das leben, durch Christum unseren herren, durch wilchen loben die engel dein herligk. etc.

Verily it is worthy and right, meet and wholesome, that we should at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, almighty everlasting God: who hast set forth the salvation of mankind on the wood of the cross, that whence death had sprung, thence life might rise again; through Christ our Lord, through whom the Angels praise thy glory, etc.

*Note.* Müntzer **omits the last clause** of the Latin, *et qui in ligno vincebat, in ligno quoque vinceretur*, "and that he who by a tree overcame might also by a tree be overcome". Erfurt and Calenberg follow him. Calenberg completes the ending with the full German common Preface, "durch welchen loben die engel … ohne ende sagende".

**German (2): Strasbourg, Schwarz** (Moderate Reformed). Diebold Schwarz's Strasbourg Mass expands that last clause with a reference to Adam and to the obedience shown on the tree. **Strasbourg, Mass of Diebold Schwarz, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 121):

> Es geburt sich furwor und ist billich, recht und heilsam, das wir dir alweg an allen orten danck sagen. O herr, heiliger, almechtiger vatter, ewiger Gott, der du unser heil durch das holtz des creutzs verschafft hast, uff das das leben von solchem keme, von welchem der todt uffgangen ist, und uff das der feyndt, so durch das holtz übertrettung uns alle in Adam überwunden hatt, wider uß gehorsam, so am holtz geleistet ist, bestritten wurde, durch Christum Jesum, unsern hern, durch welches maiestat und herlichkeyt dich die engel und alle hymmelsche ritterschafft loben, mit glichem frolocken samenthafft ryemen und preysen, zu welchen du auch unsere stymmen annemen wöllest, bitten wir mit undertheniger bekantnuß und sagen:

It is fitting in truth, and meet, right and wholesome, that we should always and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy, almighty Father, everlasting God, who hast wrought our salvation by the wood of the cross, that life might come from that from which death had arisen; and that the enemy, who through the transgression at the tree had overcome us all in Adam, might be overcome again through the obedience rendered on the tree; through Christ Jesus our Lord, through whose majesty and glory the angels and all the heavenly chivalry praise thee, and with like exultation together extol and laud thee; with whom we pray thee to accept our voices also, with humble confession, and we say:

*Notes on Schwarz's German.*

- The Latin's "he who overcame by a tree" is glossed as **the devil**, who conquered "through the transgression at the tree" "in Adam".
- The Latin's "might be overcome by a tree" becomes **"through obedience rendered on the tree"**. Christ's obedience is set against Adam's disobedience (Rom 5:19).
- The angelic orders of the common Preface are reduced to "the angels and all the heavenly chivalry".

**German (3): Dortmund (Low German).** Dortmund renders the whole Latin, the last clause included. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Vam Crütze unde Lyden Christi"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> De du des minschliken geslechts salicheit am holte des Crützes heffst gewercket, up dat, dar de dodt van her was gekamen, dar hen dat leevent wedder uth erstönde unde de dar im holte averwunnen hadde, wedderumme ock am holte averwunnen worde, Dorch Christum, unsen Heren, dorch welcken etc., nedden yn der gemenen vorrede.

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who hast wrought the salvation of mankind on the wood of the Cross, that whence death had come, thence life might rise again; and that he who had overcome by the tree might in turn be overcome on the tree; through Christ our Lord, through whom, etc., below in the common Preface.

#### 4.A.6 Easter (*Te quidem, Domine, omni tempore*)

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1154). It prints *verus est Deus* for *verus est agnus*, which Sehling's editor takes for a misprint;
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 410).

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "In die Paschae"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

> Vere dignum et iustum est, aequum et salutare, te quidem Domine, omni tempore, sed in hac potissimum die gloriosius praedicare, cum pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus. Ipse enim verus est agnus, qui abstulit peccata mundi, qui mortem nostram moriendo destruxit et vitam resurgendo reparavit, et ideo cum angelis et archangelis, cum thronis et dominationibus, cumque omni militia coelestis exercitus hymnum gloriae tuae canimus, sine fine dicentes.

It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, at all times indeed to praise thee, O Lord, but chiefly on this day more gloriously, when Christ our Passover was sacrificed. For he is the very Lamb, which hath taken away the sins of the world; who by dying hath destroyed our death, and by rising again hath restored life. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

**German (1): Müntzer** (Radical Reformation). This translation is in Müntzer 1524 and Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 376). It is also in Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 829) and Lippe 1571, "auff den Dörffern" (21, p. 410). The Low German Mass from Kiel has it too (Sehling 23, p. 56; rendered in Chapter 7, §7.11.2). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Resurrection** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 503):

> Warlich es ist wirdig und recht billich und gleich und ist heilsam, das wir herr almechtiger got dir allenthalben danksagen. Und sonderlich in dieser zeit höcher preisen, dann Christus unser osterlamp ist vor uns geopfert. Er ist das ware lamp gotes, wilchs do weg genommen hat die sunde der werlet. Der do durch seinen tod unsern ewigen tod vorstöret hat und als er auferstanden ist, hat er herwiderbracht das leben. Dorumb singen wir mit allen engeln der himlischen scharen ein leisen deines preises one ende sagende.

*Notes on Müntzer's German.*

- **The opening is the common Preface's.** *Te quidem, Domine, omni tempore … praedicare* is replaced by "that we give thanks unto thee in all places, and specially at this time praise thee more highly". The Latin's own "at all times indeed to praise thee" disappears into the common formula.
- ***In hac potissimum die*** ("chiefly on this day") becomes **"at this time"**, so the Preface serves the whole Easter season.
- ***Mortem nostram*** becomes "our **eternal** death".
- **The *Et ideo* is reduced** to "with all the angels of the heavenly hosts", and "the hymn" becomes "a *Leise*".
- **The Kiel Mass** adds that Christ died "by his **temporal** death" ("synen tytliken dot"). Lippe 1571 reads "einen lobgesang" for "ein leisen".

**German (2): Kurland.** Kurland 1570 has its own translation. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "Auf ostern"** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

> Warlich, es ist billich und gerecht, dazu gleich und ganz heilsam, das wir dir alzeit und an allen enden danksagen, und sonderlich zu dieser zeit höher preisen, dieweil Christus, unser osterlam, für uns am creuze ist geopfert, welch ist das wahre lam gottes, das dar weggenommen hat der welt sünde, der durch sein sterben den tod uberwunden hat, und durch sein auferstehung das leben herwider gebracht, darum wir mit allen engeln und mit der ganzen himlischen herscharen singen einen lobgesang deines preises ohne ende sagende.

*Notes on Kurland's German.* It follows Müntzer's shape. It adds "**on the cross**" to "sacrificed for us", and it says that Christ by his death "overcame death" instead of "destroyed our death".

**German (3): Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Ein ander Vorred"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 133):

> Recht und heylsam, das man dich allweg herrlich rüm und preyße, Dann unser osterlamb Christus ist geschlachtet. Er ist das wor lamb, das hyn nympt der welt sünde, der unsern tod durchs sterben zerstöret und das leben durch aufferstehung widerbracht hat, Deßhalb wir etc.

[It is] right and wholesome that thou be always gloriously extolled and praised; for Christ our Passover is slain. He is the true Lamb, that taketh away the sin of the world; who by dying hath destroyed our death, and by rising again hath restored life. Wherefore we, etc.

*Note.* Strasbourg keeps the Latin's own opening ("always … gloriously praised"). But it **drops *sed in hac potissimum die***: there is no "chiefly on this day".

**German (4): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Tho Paschen"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> Dy twarn, O Here, tho allen tyden, besunder överst up dessem dage (edder: desse tydt) hochtydtliker tho prysen, dar yn unse Paschen Christus ys geoffert, De sülve ys dat ware Lam, dat dar hen genomen hefft der werlt sünde. De unsen dodt dorch syn stervent hefft tho braken unde dat leevent dorch syn upstaent weddermaket. Darumme etc., wo baven tho Wynachten.

[It is very meet … wholesome,] to praise thee indeed, O Lord, at all times, but chiefly upon this day (or: this time) more festally, wherein Christ our Passover is offered. The same is the true Lamb, that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath broken our death, and by his rising hath made life anew. Therefore, etc., as above at Christmas.

*Note.* This is complete and faithful. "Chiefly upon this day" is kept, with "this time" offered as an alternative, as in Müntzer.

**German (5): the Easter text as Calenberg's Sunday Preface.** Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 prints a shorter form of the Easter Preface in its model Mass for an ordinary Sunday. That Mass has the Trinity propers: the Alleluia *Benedictus es, Domine, Deus patrum nostrorum* and the Gospel John 3. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 815):

> Warlich ist das billich und recht und heilsam, das wir dir danken, heiliger Herr, almechtiger Vater, ewiger Gott, durch Christum, unsern Herren, der das ware osterlamb ist, der ist warlich das lamb, das der welt sünde tregt, der unsern todt mit seinem sterben verstöret hat und das leben mit seiner auferstehunge erworben hat. Darumb singen wir mit seinen engeln und erzengeln deiner ehr ein lobgesang, ohn end sprechende

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we give thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who is the true Passover lamb; he is verily the Lamb that beareth the sin of the world, who by his dying hath destroyed our death, and by his resurrection hath won life. Therefore we sing with his angels and archangels a song of praise to thine honour, without end saying:

*Note.* All reference to the day and the season is gone. The Easter Preface becomes a **Sunday Preface**: every Sunday is a feast of the resurrection.

#### 4.A.7 Ascension (*Qui post resurrectionem suam*)

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 574);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155; *faceret* for *tribueret*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207).

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Ascensionis"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 574):

> Vere dignum et etc. Per Christum Dominum nostrum, qui post resurrectionem suam omnibus discipulis suis manifestus apparuit et ipsis cernentibus est elevatus in coelum, ut nos divinitatis suae tribueret esse participes, et ideo cum angelis et archangelis, cum thronis et dominationibus, cumque omni militia coelestis exercitus, hymnum gloriae tuae canimus, sine fine dicentes.

It is very meet, etc. … through Christ our Lord: who after his resurrection appeared openly unto all his disciples, and in their sight was lifted up into heaven, that he might grant us to be partakers of his Godhead. And therefore with Angels and Archangels, with Thrones and Dominions, and with all the company of the heavenly host, we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

**German (1): Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Ein ander Vorred"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 134):

> Ewiger Gott, durch Christum, unnsern herrn, Der nach seiner aufferstendtnuß seinen jüngern offentlich erschinen und in irem gesicht erhebt ist in hymmel, auff das er unß seiner gotheit teilhaftig macht, Deshalb wir etc.

Everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who after his resurrection appeared openly to his disciples, and in their sight was lifted up into heaven, that he might make us partakers of his Godhead; wherefore we, etc.

*Note.* The translation is exact, but it leaves out "all" (*omnibus*).

**German (2): Calenberg-Göttingen. Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Ascension** (Sehling 6/2, p. 831):

> Warlich, es ist billich und recht und ist heilsam, das wir dir, Herr, almechtiger Gott, allenthalben danksagen durch Christum, unseren Herren, welcher nach seiner auferstehung allen seinen jüngern offenbarlich erschinen ist und fur ihren augen aufgenomen ist in himel, auf das er uns geb, das wir seiner gottheit teilhaftig würden. Darumb singen wir mit den engeln und erzengeln, herschenden und gewaltigen engeln, auch mit der herschaft der himlischen herscharen ein lobgesang deiner herrligkeit, ohn ende sagende

*Notes on Calenberg's German.*

- This is a full and faithful translation.
- *Cum thronis et dominationibus* becomes "ruling and mighty angels", and *omni militia coelestis exercitus* becomes "the lordship of the heavenly hosts".
- Sehling's editor notes that the text is close to the Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1526.

**German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Hemmelfart Christi"** (Sehling 21, p. 210):

> Dorch Christum, unsen Heren, De na syner upstandinge alle synen Jungeren sick klarlick hefft apenbaret unde ys hüdden ansehens vor eren ogen tho hemmel gefaren, dat he uns syner Godtheit deelhafftich makede. Darumme etc., tho Wynachten.

[It is very meet …] through Christ our Lord, who after his resurrection shewed himself clearly to all his disciples, and this day, in sight before their eyes, went up into heaven, that he might make us partakers of his Godhead. Therefore, etc., [as] at Christmas.

*Note.* Dortmund adds "**this day**" ("hüdden").

#### 4.A.8 Pentecost (*Qui ascendens super omnes caelos*)

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, pp. 574–575);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);

- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207);
- Osnabrück (1588) 1618 (7/1, p. 269);
- Lippe 1571 (21, p. 411).

**The *canimus* variant.** Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel and Hoya read ***canimus*** ("we sing") where the Missal has *concinunt* ("[the Powers] sing together"). Sehling's editor marks it "[!]" in Hoya. The grammar is broken, but the sense is that the congregation joins the angels. The others read *concinunt*. In Grubenhagen the editor has restored *concinunt* against a print reading *canimus*.

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Pentecostes"** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 574–575):

> Vere dignum et iustum etc. Per Christum Dominum nostrum, qui ascendens super omnes coelos, sedensque ad dexteram tuam, promissum Spiritum sanctum hodierna die in filios adoptionis effudit. Quapropter profusis gaudiis totus in orbe terrarum mundus exultat, sed et supernae virtutes atque angelicae potestates hymnum gloriae tuae canimus, sine fine dicentes.

It is very meet and right, etc. … through Christ our Lord: who, ascending above all the heavens, and sitting at thy right hand, did on this day pour forth the promised Holy Ghost upon the children of adoption. Wherefore with overflowing joy the whole world throughout all the earth doth exult; and the Virtues on high and the angelic Powers also [with them] we sing the hymn of thy glory, evermore saying:

**German (1): Müntzer** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's translation is also in Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 377), Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 833) and Lippe 1571, "auff den Dörffern" (21, p. 411). In Sehling's edition Müntzer's Pentecost office is printed at the head of the following document (*eko.db* doc 52). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of the Holy Ghost** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 504):

> Warlich es ist wirdig und recht billich und ist heilsam, das wir dir almechtiger ewiger got allzeit und allenthalben danksagen durch Christum unseren herren. Der do aufgestigen ist in himmel und sitzt zu der rechten des vaters, und hat heut den heilgen geist, den er vorheissen hatte, ergossen in die auserwelten kinder. Dorumb ist die ganze welt voll freuden, im ganzen umkreis der erden. Dozu singet alle himlische schaer ein leisen deinem preise one ende sagende.

*Notes on Müntzer's German.*

- ***Super omnes caelos*** ("above all the heavens") becomes "into heaven".
- ***In filios adoptionis*** ("upon the children of adoption") becomes **"upon the elect children"**.
- ***Profusis gaudiis*** is dropped.
- ***Supernae virtutes atque angelicae potestates*** becomes "all the heavenly host", who "sing a *Leise*".

**German (2): Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed). **Strasbourg, *Teutsche Meß und Tauff*, 1524, "Ein ander Vorred"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 134):

> Ewiger Gott, durch Christum, unnsern hern, Der, auffgestigen über alle hymmel und sitzend zuo deiner gerechten, außgossen hat den verheyssen geist über dein an kindes statt angenommene kinder, Deßhalb mit außtringenden freüden in allem erdtrich die welt sich freüwet, auch die Engel dein lob singen und sprechen: Sanctus, Heyliger etc.

Everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who, ascended above all heavens and sitting at thy right hand, hath poured out the promised Spirit upon thy children taken in the stead of children; wherefore with overflowing joys in all the earth the world rejoiceth, and the Angels also sing thy praise and say: Sanctus, Holy, etc.

*Note.* This is close, and it keeps "above all heavens" and "adoption" ("an kindes statt angenommene"). It drops ***hodierna die***, "on this day".

**German (3): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Pingesten"** (Sehling 21, pp. 210–211):

> Dorch Christum, unsen Heren. De upfarende baven alle hemmele unde sittende tho dyner rechtern handt, hefft (hüden tho dage) den belaveden hilligen Geist yn de utherwelden Kyndere gestörtet, Des sick de gantze werlt avermaten seer hochlick vorblidet, Ja, ock de Oversten Kreffte unde Engelschen mechte singen loff dyner herlicheit, sunder ende seggende: Hillich etc.

[It is very meet …] through Christ our Lord, who, ascending above all heavens and sitting at thy right hand, hath (on this day) poured out the promised Holy Ghost upon the chosen children; whereof the whole world rejoiceth exceedingly; yea, the highest Virtues also and the angelic Powers sing the praise of thy glory, without end saying: Holy, etc.

*Notes on Dortmund's German.* Dortmund agrees with Müntzer's "**chosen children**" against the Latin's "children of adoption". It puts "today" in brackets as optional, and it has *concinunt*, not *canimus*.

#### 4.A.9 Trinity (*Qui cum unigenito Filio tuo*)

**Latin witnesses:**

- Lüneburg 1564 (6/1, p. 575);
- Wolfenbüttel 1569 (6/1, p. 181);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (6/2, p. 1074);
- Hoya 1581 (6/2, p. 1155; *essentiae* for *substantiae*);
- Verden 1606 (7/1, p. 207).

Several orders also prescribe it for **ordinary Sundays** (§4.8.2): Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hamburg 1529, Herford 1532 and Wittenberg 1533. The reason they give is that the Preface "was made against the Arians".

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564, "Trinitatis"** (Sehling 6/1, p. 575):

> Vere dignum et iustum est, aequum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere, Domine sancte Pater omnipotens, aeterne Deus, qui cum unigenito Filio tuo et Spiritu sancto unus es Deus, unus es Dominus, non in unius singularitate personae, sed in unius trinitate substantiae. Quod enim de tua gloria revelante te credimus, hoc de Filio tuo, hoc de Spiritu sancto sine differentia discretionis sentimus, ut in confessione verae sempiternaeque deitatis et in personis proprietas et in essentia unitas et in maiestate adoretur aequalitas, quam laudant angeli, adorant dominationes, tremunt potestates, coeli coelorumque virtutes ac beata seraphin socia exultatione concelebrant. Cum quibus et nostras voces, ut admitti iubeas te precamur supplici confessione dicentes.

It is very meet and right, just and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O holy Lord, Father almighty, everlasting God: who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one God, one Lord; not in the singleness of one Person, but in the Trinity of one substance. For that which by thy revelation we believe of thy glory, the same we believe of thy Son, the same of the Holy Ghost, without any difference or separation; that in the confession of the true and everlasting Godhead there may be adored in the Persons propriety, in the essence unity, and in the majesty equality: which the Angels praise, the Dominions adore, the Powers tremble at, the heavens and the Virtues of the heavens and the blessed Seraphim with one accord celebrate with exultation. With whom we beseech thee that thou wouldest bid our voices also to be admitted, saying with lowly confession:

*Note.* The ending is that of the common Preface: *quam laudant angeli, adorant dominationes* …. It is not the *Cherubim quoque ac Seraphim, qui non cessant clamare* of the later Roman form.

**German (1): Lippe, Low German. Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538], Trinity Sunday** (Sehling 22, p. 568):

> Warlyck, edt is byllick unde recht, dartho ock yst seer heilsam, dat wy dy altydt und yn allen enden danck seggen. Here, heillyge vader, almechtige, ewyge Godt, welcker du myt dynem eyngebornen soen und dem hilligen geiste eyn enyge Godt bist, eyn enyger here bist. Nicht yn eynycheit der personen, sonder yn der enycheit eynes sunderliken wesens. Den dat wy durch dyn sulvest apenbarynge von dyner herlicheit gheloven, even dat sulffte holden wy underscheiden van dynem sone und dem hilligen geiste, up dat yn der bekentnysse der waren und ewyghen godtheit de eghenschop yn den personen und enyccheit [!] yn dem wesen und de ghelicheit yn der majestat recht werde anghebetet, welke de engel laven, erwerdigen de ertzeengel, dartho Cherubin und Seraphin, de ane unterladt myt eyndrechtiger stemmen syngen:

*Notes on the Lippe Low German.*

- ***Sed in unius trinitate substantiae*** ("but in the Trinity of one substance") becomes "but in the **unity** of one peculiar being". The word "Trinity" is lost.
- ***Sine differentia discretionis*** ("without difference or separation") becomes "**that same we hold distinctly** of thy Son and the Holy Ghost". The negative is lost, and the clause seems to say the opposite of the Latin.

- **The angelic ending** follows the other Roman form: "the angels praise, the archangels worship, and Cherubim and Seraphim … sing without ceasing with one voice". Compare *Angeli atque Archangeli, Cherubim quoque ac Seraphim, qui non cessant clamare*.

**German (2): Dortmund (Low German). Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Van der Hilligen Drevoldicheit"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

> De mit dynem eingebaren Söne unde dem hilligen Geiste bist ein Godt, ein Here, nicht yn einer personen enicheit, sunder ynn eines wesendes drevoldicheit. Wente dat wy van dyner herlicheit dorch dyn apenbarent gelöven, dat völe wy ock van dynem Söne unde van dem Hilligen Geiste, sunder jenich underscheides, voranderinge, Also dat ynn der bekenninge der warachtigen, ewigen Godtheit ein underscheit yn den personen, ein enicheit yn dem wesende unde doch gelickheit yn der herlichen angebedet werde. De dar de Engelen laven etc., als yn der gemenen Prefation.

[It is very meet … everlasting God:] Who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one God, one Lord; not in the oneness of a person, but in the trinity of one being. For what we believe of thy glory through thy revealing, that we feel also of thy Son and of the Holy Ghost, without any difference [or] change; so that in the confession of the true, everlasting Godhead a distinction in the Persons, a unity in the being, and yet an equality in the glory be adored. Which the Angels praise, etc., as in the common Preface.

*Note.* This is faithful. *Proprietas* becomes "a distinction", and *discretionis* becomes "change".

#### 4.A.10 The Blessed Virgin (*Et te in … beatae Mariae*), and Müntzer's Advent rewording

**Witnesses:**

- **Dortmund 1554:** the Marian Preface itself, for the Purification, Annunciation, Visitation, Assumption and Nativity of Mary.
- **Müntzer 1524 (Advent; Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525 (Trinity, also used in Advent) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (Advent):** a reworded form, which turns the praise of Mary's feast into thanksgiving for the Incarnation.

No Latin text is printed in the corpus. The German renders the Missal's *Et te in [festivitate] beatae Mariae semper Virginis collaudare, benedicere et praedicare. Quae et Unigenitum tuum Sancti Spiritus obumbratione concepit: et virginitatis gloria permanente, lumen aeternum mundo effudit, Iesum Christum Dominum nostrum.*

**German (1): Dortmund (Low German), the Marian feasts. Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Inn Marien Festen"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

> Unde dynem dage (der reyningen, der Bodtschop, der Heymsökinge edder des Berchganges, der hemmelfart, der Gebort etc.) Marien, der hilligen steden Junckfrouwen, mit fröliken herten thosamen laven, benedyen unde hochlick prysen, De dynen eingebaren Söne yn averschemminge des hilligen Geistes hefft entfangen unde beholdener eeren der junckfrouwschop desser werlt dat ewige licht geberet, Jhesum Christum, unsen Heren, Dorch welcken etc., yn der gemenen prefation.

[It is very meet … to give thanks unto thee,] and on thy day (of the Purification, of the Annunciation, of the Visitation or Going over the Mountain, of the Assumption, of the Nativity, etc.) of Mary, the holy, ever Virgin, with joyful hearts together to praise, bless and highly extol; who conceived thine only-begotten Son by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, and, the honour of her virginity remaining, brought forth to this world the everlasting light, Jesus Christ our Lord; through whom, etc., in the common Preface.

*Notes on Dortmund's German.*

- **"Thy day … of Mary".** The Missal's "in the festival of blessed Mary" becomes "on **thy** day … of Mary". The feast is God's, and the Virgin is its occasion.
- **The Assumption is still listed** ("der hemmelfart", 15 August).
- *Effudit* ("poured forth") becomes "brought forth".

**German (2): Müntzer's rewording for Advent** (Radical Reformation). Müntzer's form is also in Erfurt 1525 (2, p. 378) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (6/2, p. 818). **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, office of Advent** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 500):

> Warlich, es ist billich und recht und ist heilsam, das wir dir, herr, o heiliger vater, almechtiger, ewiger got, allzeit und allenthalben danksagen. Dann du dein heilige menscheit von der junkfrauen Maria hast empfangen durch die umbschetigung des heilgen geistes, das sie mit unvorruckter keuscheit das ewige licht zur welt gebracht hat, Jesum Christum, unseren herren. Durch wilchen loben die engel dein herligkeit und ehr erbieten die engel, do du innen hirschest; es entsetzten sich die gewaltigen engel; dozu die himmel und der himmel krefte und die heiligen seraphin preisen dich on unterlass mit einmütiger freuden. Drumb bitten wir dich, o herr, das du woltest unsere stimmen mit in zu lassen, das wir dich mit warem bekentnis mügen loben one ende, sagende:

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God. For thou hast received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, so that she with unblemished chastity brought the everlasting light into the world, Jesus Christ our Lord: through whom the angels praise thy glory, and the angels in whom thou reignest do thee honour; the mighty angels tremble; and the heavens and the powers of the heavens and the holy Seraphim praise thee without ceasing with one accord of joy. Therefore we pray thee, O Lord, that thou wouldest admit our voices with them, that we may praise thee with true confession, without end saying:

*Notes on Müntzer's rewording.*

- **Mary's feast is gone.** The clause "and on the festival of blessed Mary to praise, bless and proclaim thee" is struck out.
- **The subject changes.** It is no longer Mary who "conceived thine Only-begotten". It is God who "received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary". The Preface becomes a thanksgiving for the Incarnation, fit for Advent.
- **The common ending is translated**, with *dominationes* as "the angels in whom thou reignest".
- **Erfurt 1525** prints the same text in its Trinity office. Its Advent office takes the whole Preface from there, and its Passion office takes "the beginning together with the conclusion" (Sehling 2, pp. 379–380).

#### 4.A.11 The Apostles (*Et te, Domine, suppliciter exorare*)

**Witness:** Dortmund 1554 only. No Latin is printed in the corpus. The Low German renders the Missal's *Et te, Domine, suppliciter exorare, ut gregem tuum, pastor aeterne, non deseras: sed per beatos Apostolos tuos continua protectione custodias. Ut iisdem rectoribus gubernetur, quos operis tui vicarios eidem contulisti praeesse pastores.* **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554, "Van den Apostolen"** (Sehling 21, p. 211):

> Dy Here, demötlick tho bidden, dat du, O ewige Herde, dyne Schape nicht vorlatest, sunder dorch dyner hilligen Apostolen lere vor allem erdom ynn stedeliker höde bewarest, dat se dorch der sülven regenten lere geleidet werden, de du en dynes werckes, plegers an dyner stede ym worde vor tho syn tho Herden heffst gegeven, Derhalven mit den Engelen unde Ertzengelen etc., baven, tho Wynachten.

[It is very meet … wholesome,] humbly to beseech thee, O Lord, that thou, O everlasting Shepherd, forsake not thy sheep, but through the doctrine of thy holy Apostles keep them in continual guard from all error; that they may be led by the doctrine of the same rulers, whom thou hast given them for shepherds, stewards of thy work, to be over them in thy stead in the word. Therefore with the Angels and Archangels, etc., above, at Christmas.

*Notes on Dortmund's German.*

- **"Through thy blessed Apostles" becomes "through the doctrine of thy holy Apostles … from all error".** The Apostles keep the flock by their teaching, not by their intercession.
- **"By the same rulers" becomes "by the doctrine of the same rulers"**, again teaching, not rule.
- ***Vicarios*** becomes "stewards … in thy stead **in the word**".

#### 4.A.12 Passiontide and Maundy Thursday: Grubenhagen's Isaiah 53 Preface (new German text)

**Witness:** Grubenhagen 1581. "So that the simple layman may be awakened more devoutly to the contemplation of the sufferings and death of Christ", the order adds "a German preface taken from the 53rd chapter of Isaiah". It is to be sung "on Maundy Thursday, or else at any time when there are many communicants". It is a new composition with notes, built on the frame of the German common Preface. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1074):

> Warlich, es ist billich und recht, löblich und auch heilsam, das wir dir immer und ewiglich, Gott Vater, danksagen, das du uns deinen lieben Son geschenket hast, der mit seinem bittern leiden bezahlet hat, was Adam und wir verschuldet han,

> wie Esaias sagt: Fürwar, er trug unser krankheit und lud auf sich unser schmerzen. Er ist umb unser missethat willen verwundet und umb unser sünde willen so zuschlagen; die straffe ligt auf ihm, auf das wir friede hetten, und durch seine wunden sind wir geheilet. Wir gingen alle irr, gleich wie die schafe, die keinen hirten haben. Ein jeglicher sah auf seinen weg. Aber der Herr warf unser aller sünd auf ihn, ein untregliche last, darunter er blutigen schweis geschwitzet hat und am stam des kreuzes geschrieen hat: Mein Gott, mein Gott, warumb hastu mich verlassen?, auf das wir nicht ewig würden verlassen. Darumb wir dir mit den engeln und erzengeln, mit den thronen und den herschaften und mit allem himlischem heer den lobgesang deiner ehre singen, immer und ewig sagende

Verily it is meet and right, laudable and also wholesome, that we should give thanks unto thee, God the Father, evermore and everlastingly, for that thou hast given us thy dear Son, who by his bitter suffering hath paid what Adam and we had deserved; as Isaiah saith: Surely he hath borne our griefs and carried our sorrows. He was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities; the chastisement is upon him, that we might have peace, and with his stripes we are healed. All we like sheep have gone astray, as sheep that have no shepherd; we have turned every one to his own way. But the Lord laid on him the sin of us all, an unbearable burden, under which he sweat bloody sweat, and on the stem of the cross cried: My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? that we might not be forsaken for ever. Therefore with the angels and archangels, with the thrones and the dominions, and with all the heavenly host, we sing unto thee the hymn of thine honour, evermore and ever saying:

#### 4.A.13 Michaelmas: Lippe's German Preface for the villages (new German text)

**Witness:** Lippe 1571. For the towns, Lippe sets the Latin common Preface "In die Michaelis" (§4.A.1). For the villages it gives a German Preface of its own. This keeps the opening of the common Preface but replaces the choirs of angels with the forgiveness of sins. On the feast of St Michael and All Angels, the angels are named only in the Sanctus. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571, "Am tage Michaelis auff den Dörffern"** (Sehling 21, p. 411):

> Warlich, es ist billich und recht und ist heilsam, das wir dich, Herre, O Heiliger Vater, Allmechtiger, Ewiger Gott, allzeit und allenthalben dancksagen durch Christum unsern Herren. Umb welches willen du uns verschonest, vergibst uns unsere sünden und verheischest die Ewige wolfart. Des wir danckbarlich singen einen Lobgesang deiner Herrligkeit one ende sagende: Sanctus.

Verily it is meet and right and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord: for whose sake thou sparest us, forgivest us our sins, and promisest everlasting welfare. Wherefore we thankfully sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying: Holy.

#### 4.A.14 Christmas in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Nativity prefixed (new German text)

**Witness:** Kurland 1570. "On the high feasts, for variation (as is done at the princely court)", the minister may sing "these prefaces noted below, in place of the *quotidiana*". The **Christmas** Preface is not the Roman Christmas text. It is the German Easter Preface, with the Virgin Birth set in front of the Lamb. The minister and choir sing the dialogue in alternation. The Easter Preface follows (§4.A.6, German 2), then a Pentecost Preface, which is the Easter text again with the Ascension and the sending of the Spirit added (§4.A.15). **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "Auf Nativitatis"** (Sehling 5, pp. 89–90):

> Der diener: Der herre sei mit euch. Das chor: Und mit deinem geist. Der diener: Erhebet eure herzen. Das chor: Wir heben sie zum herren. Der diener: Last uns dank sagen gotte, unserem herren. Das chor: Es ist billich und gerecht. Der diener: Warlich, es ist billich und gerecht, Da zugleich ganz und heilsam, Das wir dir alzeit Und an allen enden dank sagen, Und sonderlich zu dieser zeit höher preisen, Dieweil uns ein jungfreulein zart Den sohne gottes geboren hat, Welch ist das wahre lam gottes, Das da weggenommen hat der welt sünde, Der durch sein sterben Den tod uberwunden hat, Und durch sein auferstehung Das leben her wider gebracht, Darum wir mit allen englen Und mit der ganzen himlischen herscharen Singen einen lobgesang deines preises Ohne ende sagende.

The minister: The Lord be with you. The choir: And with thy spirit. The minister: Lift up your hearts. The choir: We lift them up unto the Lord. The minister: Let us give thanks unto God our Lord. The choir: It is meet and right. The minister: Verily it is meet and right, and withal wholly wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, and especially at this time praise thee more highly, because a tender little maiden hath borne unto us the Son of God, who is the true Lamb of God that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath overcome death, and by his resurrection hath brought life again. Therefore with all the angels and with all the heavenly hosts we sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying:

#### 4.A.15 Pentecost in Kurland: the Easter Preface with the Ascension and Pentecost added (new German text)

**Witness:** Kurland 1570. This is the Easter Preface of §4.A.6 (German 2), extended. Before the Sanctus it adds that Christ, "when he was taken visibly into heaven", sent down the Comforter. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570, "Auf pfingsten"** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

> Warlich, es ist billich und gerecht, dazu gleich und ganz heilsam, das wir dir alzeit und an allen enden danksagen, und sonderlich zu dieser zeit höher preisen, dieweil Christus, unser osterlam für uns am creuze ist geopfert, welch ist das ware lam gottes, das dar weggenommen hat der welt sünde, der durch sein sterben den tod uberwunden hat und durch sein auferstehung das leben her widergebracht, und als er sichtlich zu himel genommen ist, hat er den tröster, den heiligen geist, seinen gleubigen hernieder gesant, darum wir mit allen engeln und mit der ganzen himlischen herscharen singen einen lobgesang deines preises ohne ende sagende.

Verily it is meet and right, and withal wholly wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, and especially at this time praise thee more highly, because Christ our Passover lamb is sacrificed for us upon the cross, who is the true Lamb of God that hath taken away the sin of the world; who by his dying hath overcome death and by his resurrection hath brought life again; and when he was taken up visibly into heaven, he sent down the Comforter, the Holy Ghost, upon his faithful. Therefore with all the angels and with all the heavenly hosts we sing a song of praise of thy glory, without end saying:

#### 4.A.16 Summary: which Prefaces each order has

| Preface | Latin in the corpus | German or Low German in the corpus |
|---|---|---|
| Common (*Quotidiana*) | Lüneburg 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Verden 1606; for Michaelmas: Hoya 1581, Osnabrück 1618, Lippe 1571; cut short: Luther 1523, Nürnberg 1524 | Dortmund 1554; Kantz, Worms (Moderate Reformed), Volprecht, Döber, Bremen (see Chapter 7) |
| Christmas | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571 | Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525, Calenberg 1542, Lippe 1571; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Kurland 1570 (new text, §4.A.14) |
| Epiphany | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Verden | Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554 |
| Lent | — | Dortmund 1554 |
| Passion and Cross | — | Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg; Strasbourg (Schwarz) 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Grubenhagen 1581 (new Isaiah 53 text, §4.A.12) |
| Easter | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571 | Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg, Lippe 1571, Kiel; Kurland 1570; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Calenberg's Sunday form |
| Ascension | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Hoya, Verden | Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Calenberg 1542; Dortmund 1554 |
| Pentecost | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden, Osnabrück, Lippe 1571 | Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg, Lippe 1571; Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed); Dortmund 1554; Kurland 1570 (§4.A.15) |
| Trinity | Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel, Grubenhagen, Hoya, Verden | Lippe 1525; Dortmund 1554 |

| Preface | Latin in the corpus | German or Low German in the corpus |
|---|---|---|
| Blessed Virgin | — | Dortmund 1554; Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Erfurt, Calenberg (reworded for Advent and Trinity) |
| Apostles | — | Dortmund 1554 |
| Michaelmas (new German text) | (common Preface) | Lippe 1571 (§4.A.13) |

# Chapter 5. Collect, Secret and Postcommunion

This chapter follows the three **presidential prayers** of the medieval Mass through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*:

- the **collect** (*collecta*, *oratio*), said after the Gloria and before the epistle;
- the **secret** (*secreta*, *oratio super oblata*), said silently over the gifts at the end of the offertory;
- the **postcommunion** (*postcommunio*, *complenda*, *ad complendum*), said after the communion;
- on the weekdays of Lent, a fourth: the **prayer over the people** (*oratio super populum*), said after the postcommunion before the dismissal.

In the medieval rite all three were **proper**: each Sunday and feast had its own set, printed together in the Missal. They were also **multiplied**. A Mass of the day could add the collect of a commemorated feast or octave, or a votive prayer (for peace, for rain, for the ruler). Each added collect brought its own secret and postcommunion with it, so that two collects meant two secrets and two postcommunions.

For each prayer the chapter asks:

- What did the Lutheran orders **keep** of the old system?
- What did they **strip**?
- What did they **add**?
- What did they **alter**?

It gives particular attention to the claim that the postcommunion was **standardized into a fixed prayer**, Luther's thanksgiving of 1526, and to the other postcommunions that stood beside it, among them versions of the old Missal prayers.

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §5.1 summarizes the findings, and §5.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §5.3 describes the medieval system and Luther's two rulings, of 1523 and 1526.
- §5.4 deals with the collect, §5.5 with the secret, and §5.6 with the postcommunion and, in §5.6.6, the Lenten prayer over the people.
- §5.7 sets out what was kept, stripped, added and altered.
- §5.8 is a table by order, and §5.9 a concordance.
- Appendix 5.A lists the postcommunion texts and their sources.

## 5.1 Summary of findings

**1. Luther set the pattern in two steps** (§5.3).

- **1523, *Formula missae*.** One collect of the day only, "if it be godly". No secret, because it fell with the offertory. The proper postcommunions were rejected because "they almost all sound of sacrifice". In their place came two of the priest's ablution prayers, *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum*, the same every Sunday.
- **1526, *Deutsche Messe*.** One German collect, and one fixed German thanksgiving after the communion: "Wir danken dir, allmächtiger Herr Gott, dass du uns durch diese heilsame Gabe hast erquicket …". Sehling's Verden editor, after P. Drews, traces this prayer to the Missal postcommunion of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost, *Gratias tibi referimus … sacro munere vegetati*. Luther changed its petition from "make us worthy" to "make it prosper in us unto faith and love".

**2. The collect: kept, proper, and mostly from the Missal** (§5.4).

- **Kept de tempore.** Every order with a Mass has a collect after the Gloria, of the season or feast. The territorial orders print German series by the church year (Saxony 1539 and 1580, Lüneburg 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Henneberg 1582, Grubenhagen 1581, Oldenburg 1573, Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1618).
- **From the Missal.** Sehling's editors trace many of these collects to Missal collects (*Excita*, *Concede … nova per carnem nativitas*, *Deus qui hodierna die corda fidelium*), mostly by way of the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533 and the translations of Michael Coelius.

- **Reduced to one, with exceptions.** Luther's rule of one collect was common (Volprecht 1524, Mecklenburg 1545). But a **second collect for need** survived: Mecklenburg allows it, and Ansbach 1548 requires two, the first for spiritual and the second for temporal things. Hof 1592 has the votive "for rain and fair weather". The collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* (*Deus, a quo sancta desideria*) became the standing second collect at the end of the service.
- **Purged.** Collects asking the intercession of the saints went (Hannover 1536). The rest were kept "if pure" (Amberg 1550, Henneberg 1582).
- **Added.** Veit Dietrich's **gospel collects** (from 1546) were written on the day's gospel rather than the season. Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Soest 1609 allow them. In Buxtehude 1565 each Sunday has two collects, a Missal collect before the sermon and Dietrich's after it.
- **Altered.** Collects moved into German so the people could answer Amen (Coburg 1554/55, Wolfstein 1574). Hof 1592 still teaches the medieval rules for the collect conclusions.

**3. The secret: abolished** (§5.5).

- **No secret in any order.** No order keeps a secret, and the corpus has no German version of one. It fell with the offertory: Prussia 1525 lists "offertory, secret, *canon minor* and *maior*" among the things "of necessity left out".
- **Remnants.** What remains is:
  - the secret's sung ending *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* before the Preface (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe, Calenberg-Göttingen);
  - its name and place in Dortmund 1554, where the priest makes "an open prayer for all magistrates, estates and needs of the whole Christendom" instead;
  - collects for the Church and rulers said aloud under the Sanctus (Döber 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543).

**4. The postcommunion: an ordinary prayer, but never only one** (§5.6).

- **Luther's 1523 prayers.** They were kept in Latin as the priest's devotion (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543) and put into German as the *Complenda* (Strasbourg 1524, Moderate Reformed).
- **Proper postcommunions kept for a time.** Some orders kept the proper postcommunions of the Missal:
  - the Nürnberg parish Mass and Volprecht (1524), and Coburg 1524;
    - Müntzer (1524, Radical Reformation), with German versions of the Easter postcommunion *Spiritum nobis … tuae caritatis infunde* and the Pentecost *Sancti Spiritus … infusio*;
  - Erfurt (1525), which adds the Trinity *Proficiat*;
  - **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**, which prints, for each feast, Luther's thanksgiving followed by a proper postcommunion from the Missal (Advent *Suscipiamus*, Easter, Pentecost). This is the last order in the corpus to do so.
- **Luther's thanksgiving became the ordinary.** From the 1530s it is the standard Lutheran postcommunion, and some orders still call it "the complenda" (Hatzkerode, Reuss 1552, Breslau 1550).
- **The alternatives beside it.** Almost every order prints one or two alternatives, "or this":
  - the **Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533** ("Wir sagen deiner göttlichen Mildigkeit Lob und Dank"), an expansion of *Quod ore sumpsimus*. Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 sing it with Luther's "under one conclusion", as two collects;
  - a German version of the **Corpus Christi collect** *Deus, qui nobis sub sacramento mirabili* ("Ach du lieber Herre Gott, der du uns bei diesem wunderbarlichen Sakrament …"): Mecklenburg 1545, Buxtehude 1565, Oldenburg 1573, Saxony and Mansfeld 1580, Grubenhagen 1581, Nördlingen 1579;
  - **Döber's prayer** of 1525, taken up by Mecklenburg;
  - Prussia 1544's second collect, sung on alternate Sundays.
- **Without communicants.** Where no one communicated, a free collect, or a "thanksgiving for the word of God heard" (Lippe 1571), took the postcommunion's place.

**5. The Lenten prayer over the people: gone from the Mass, kept once in the office** (§5.6.6).

- **Not at the Mass.** No order keeps the *oratio super populum* or its bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo* at the end of the Mass. The blessing "over the people" at the end of the Lutheran Mass is the Aaronic blessing.
- **At Lauds, in Ansbach.** The Brandenburg-Ansbach order for the collegiate churches (1533) strikes out the Lenten Lauds collects that "speak of the fast". In their place it allows "the *super populum* that followeth": the prayer over the people of

the same day, which asks for God's protection without reference to fasting.

**6. The overall pattern** (§5.7).

- **Kept:** the collect of the day, mostly from the Missal; the shape *Dominus vobiscum*, *Oremus*, prayer and long conclusion, *Amen*; the idea of a closing prayer after the communion, still often called the *complenda*.
- **Stripped:** the secret entirely; the Lenten *super populum* at the Mass; the proper postcommunion (after a transition ending in 1542); commemorations of saints; the automatic multiplication of collects.
- **Added:** Luther's fixed thanksgiving; the Nürnberg thanksgiving; Dietrich's gospel collects; collects for rulers under the Sanctus; the peace collect at the end.
- **Altered:** Latin to German; the postcommunion from a proper to an ordinary, with alternatives; the sacrificial petitions of the old prayers recast as petitions for faith, love and the fruit of the sacrament.

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## 5.2 Scope, sources and cautions

**What was searched.** The `eko.db` database was searched for the three prayers by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *collecta*, *collecte*, *collecten*, *oratio*, *gebet*;
- *secreta*, *secret*, *stillmesse*, *super oblata*;
- *complenda*, *complende*, *postcommunio*, *post communionem*, *danksagung*, *danckseggінge*;
- *super populum*, *super plebem*, *humiliate capita*, *inclinate capita*, "über das Volk", "neiget eure Häupter".

It was also searched for the opening words of the prayers that the orders use after the communion: *Quod ore sumpsimus*, *Corpus tuum*, *Proficiat*, "Wir danken dir … heilsame Gabe", "Wir sagen deiner göttlichen Mildigkeit", "wunderbarlichen Sakrament", "heiligen Mut, guten Rat". Sehling's editorial notes that identify Missal sources ("Röm. Meßbuch", "Missale", "lateinisches Meßgebet") were read for every order quoted. The passages were then read in context.

**Related chapters.** Three earlier chapters overlap with this one:

- Chapter 7 prints the eucharistic part of the early German Masses in full, including their offertory, Sanctus collects, thanksgivings and postcommunions. Where a text is printed there, this chapter cites it rather than repeating it.
- Chapter 4 deals with the other proper parts of the Mass: introit, lessons, gradual, offertory chant, Preface, communion chant.
- Chapter 8 deals with the hymns, including *Verleih uns Frieden*, after which the peace collect is sung.

Later chapters take up related subjects:

- Chapter 2 covers the salutation and collect in the order of the Mass, and the service when nobody communicated (§§2.8, 2.14).
- Chapter 6 covers the three collects read from the pulpit as a family of the general prayer (§6.15).
- Chapter 10 covers the collects of Matins and Vespers (§§10.7.1, 10.7.5).
- Chapter 13 covers the Litany and its collects (§13.22).
- Chapter 12 covers the seasons whose collects were kept (§12.12).

Where an order gives the collect to a deacon or junior minister, as at Hof, see Chapter 16.

**Cautions.** Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "a collect" or "the collect with the blessing", without saying which. Where an order prints a collect series, it may not print the rubric for using it, and the reverse.
- **Sources of the German prayers.** The identification of a German prayer with a Latin one is in most cases Sehling's editors'. Where the identification is this chapter's own, it is marked as such. The German is often free.
- **The Missal used.** The editors cite the Roman Missal of their own day, or a diocesan Missal (Bamberg, Verden, Bremen, Magdeburg). The Latin texts given here are those of the Roman Missal. The Sarum Missal shares most of these collects and postcommunions with the Roman, though it numbers the Sundays after Trinity rather than after Pentecost. The

German texts therefore cannot show whether a prayer came by a Sarum or a Roman route; in the German lands the source was in any case the local diocesan Missal.

- **Beyond the corpus.** The corpus ends in the early seventeenth century. It says nothing directly about the later Lutheran service books, including the Common Service and its postcommunions. §5.6.2 notes the points of contact.

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## 5.3 The medieval system and Luther's rulings

### 5.3.1 What the reformers inherited

**The three prayers.** In the late-medieval Mass the celebrant said three variable prayers, each ending with the long conclusion (*Per Dominum nostrum …*):

- the **collect** after the Gloria, sung aloud;
- the **secret** at the end of the offertory, said silently over the bread and wine, of which only the closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum* was sung aloud, as the opening of the Preface dialogue;
- the **postcommunion** or *complenda* after the communion, sung aloud.

**Proper and multiplied.** All three changed with the day. They were also added to. Commemorations of a feast falling on the same day, of an octave, or of a season brought their own collect, secret and postcommunion. Votive prayers (for peace, for the ruler, for rain or fair weather) were added in the same way. Sehling's editors gloss the terms where the orders use them: the *complenda* is "the closing collect" ("die Schlußkollekte", Sehling 20/1, p. 123, n. 29) and "today called the postcommunion" (Sehling 11, p. 49, n. 24).

### 5.3.2 Luther's *Formula missae*, 1523: one collect, no secret, a new postcommunion

**"Hireling collects."** Luther's preface to the *Formula missae* lists the collects among the late accretions that made the Mass a sacrifice. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 4):

> ibi cepit missa fieri sacrificium, ibi addita offertoria et collectae mercenariae, ibi sequentiae et prosae inter Sanctus et Gloria in excelsis insertae.

there the Mass began to be made a sacrifice; there were added the offertories and the hireling collects; there the sequences and proses were inserted between the Sanctus and the Gloria in excelsis.

**The collect: kept, but only one.** The collect of the day is kept, "if only it be godly", and Luther notes that the Sunday collects mostly are. But it is to be said alone: no commemorations, no second or third collect. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Tertio, sequens oratio illa seu collecta, modo sit pia (ut fere sunt, quae dominicis diebus habentur), perseveret ritu suo, sed ea duntaxat unica. Post hanc lectio epistolae.

Thirdly, the prayer or collect which followeth, if only it be godly (as for the most part are those which are appointed for the Lord's days), let it continue in its accustomed rite, but that one alone. After this the reading of the epistle.

**The secret: gone with the offertory.** Luther rejects the whole offertory, "whence also it is called the offertory", because from there on "almost everything soundeth and savoureth of oblation" (Sehling 1, p. 5). The secret, the prayer over the oblation, falls with it. The text and the details are given in Chapter 7, §7.3.1.

**The postcommunion: the proper *complenda* replaced.** The proper postcommunions are rejected for the same reason: "they almost all sound of sacrifice". In their place Luther puts two of the priest's private prayers from the ablutions, said aloud in the collect tone. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

> Sed loco complendae seu ultimae collectae, quia fere sacrificium sonant, legatur in eodem tono oratio illa: 'Quod ore sumpsimus, domine'. Poterit et illa legi: 'Corpus tuum, domine, quod sumpsimus etc.' mutato numero in pluralem.

But in the place of the complenda or last collect, because they almost all sound of sacrifice, let that prayer be read in the same tone: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord". That other also may be read: "Thy body, O Lord, which we have received, etc.", the number being changed into the plural.

The two prayers are:

- ***Quod ore sumpsimus***: *Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus, et de munere temporali fiat nobis remedium sempiternum.* "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord, may we receive with a pure mind; and from a temporal gift may it become for us an everlasting remedy."
- ***Corpus tuum***: *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsi, et Sanguis, quem potavi, adhaereat visceribus meis …* "Thy Body, O Lord, which I have taken, and thy Blood, which I have drunk, cleave unto my inmost parts …"

**What this did to the system.** In one stroke the *Formula missae* reduced the three proper prayers to one. The collect stayed proper. The secret was gone. The postcommunion became, for the first time, an **ordinary**: the same prayer every Sunday.

#### 5.3.3 Luther's *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: one collect and a fixed thanksgiving

**The collect.** The *Deutsche Messe* gives one collect, read by the priest "facing the altar" on a fixed pitch. The example printed is a German collect from the Missal. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Darnach lieset der priester eine collecten ins F faut in unisono, wie folget. Almechtiger Gott, der du bist ein beschutzer aller die auf dich hoffen, an welchs gnad niemand ichts vermag noch etwas fur dir gild, lasse deine barmherzigkeyt uns reichlich widerfarn, auf das wir durch dein heiliges eingeben denken was recht ist, und durch deine kraft auch dasselbige volbringen umb Jesus Christus unsers hern willen. Amen.

Thereafter the priest readeth a collect on F fa ut in unison, as followeth: Almighty God, who art the protector of all that hope in thee, without whose grace no man is able to do aught, nor is anything of worth before thee; let thy mercy richly come upon us, that by thy holy inspiration we may think those things that be right, and by thy power also perform the same; for Jesus Christ our Lord's sake. Amen.

**Its source.** The first half is the collect *Protector in te sperantium, Deus, sine quo nihil est validum, nihil sanctum: multiplica super nos misericordiam tuam* (third Sunday after Pentecost, the fourth after Trinity). The editors of the Lüneburg order identify the Missal prayer (Sehling 6/1, p. 572, n. 70). The second half follows, in this chapter's reading, the Rogate collect *Deus, a quo bona cuncta procedunt … ut cogitemus, te inspirante, quae recta sunt, et te gubernante eadem faciamus*. The *Deutsche Messe* collect thus fuses two Missal collects into one German prayer.

**The postcommunion: a single fixed thanksgiving.** After the communion the *Deutsche Messe* has one prayer, with no alternative, followed by the Aaronic blessing. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

> Darnach folget die collecten mit dem segen. Wir dancken dir, almechtiger herre gott, das du uns durch dise heilsame gabe hast erquicket und bitten deine barmherzigkeit, das du uns solchs gedeien lassest zu starckem glauben gegen dir und zu brinstiger liebe unter uns allen, umb Jhesus Christus unsers herrn willen. Amen.

Thereafter followeth the collect with the blessing. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; for Jesus Christ our Lord's sake. Amen.

**Its source.** This is not a new composition but an old postcommunion, recast. The editor of the Verden order of 1606 points to P. Drews, who traced it to the postcommunion of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606, editor's note** (Sehling 7/1, p. 161, n. 81):

> zum lateinischen Ursprung der Kollekte (Postcommunio der Messe des 18. Sonntags nach Pfingsten im Missale): P. Drews, Beiträge zu Luthers liturgischen Reformen. 1910, 95f.

on the Latin origin of the collect (the postcommunion of the Mass of the eighteenth Sunday after Pentecost in the Missal): P. Drews, *Beiträge zu Luthers liturgischen Reformen*, 1910, pp. 95f.

The Latin is *Gratias tibi referimus, Domine, sacro munere vegetati: tuam misericordiam deprecantes, ut dignos nos eius participatione perficias*: "We give thee thanks, O Lord, being quickened by the sacred gift, beseeching thy mercy that thou wouldest make us worthy of the partaking thereof." Luther kept the frame ("we give thanks … refreshed by the gift … we beseech thy mercy"). He changed the petition: not that we be made **worthy** of the sacrament, but that it **prosper in us** unto faith toward God and love toward one another.

**The result.** One proper postcommunion of the year, made over, became the fixed postcommunion of the *Deutsche Messe*. Through the Saxon and Low German orders it became the ordinary Lutheran postcommunion (§5.6.3).

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## 5.4 The collect

### 5.4.1 One collect, or two

**Luther's rule: one.** The *Formula missae* allowed "that one alone" (§5.3.2). The early Nürnberg Masses follow it:

- **Volprecht's Mass, 1524**, lists the parts of the Mass with what is "always said" and "never said". Of the collect it says: "only one is said". **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 39):

> Gl[or]ia in excelsis Deo semper dicitur. Collecta: una t[ant]um d[ici]tur. Ep[isto]la, Graduale, v[ersus], Alleluja, v[ersus].

Gloria in excelsis Deo is always said. Collect: one only is said. Epistle, gradual, verse, Alleluia, verse.

- **The Nürnberg parish churches, 1524**: "the celebrant sings the Sunday prayer, *Sancti tui nominis* etc." (Sehling 11, p. 46). Sehling's note explains: "the prayer falling on the Sunday in question (the collect)".

**The memorial collect survives as a prayer "for need".** Mecklenburg 1545 keeps Luther's rule but leaves room for a second collect in time of need. It also forbids reading the same collect every time, and reading a collect out of its season. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 152):

> Me schal ock men eine collecten tor tidt lesen. Idt were den sake, dat ander grot noth vorhanden were, de noch ein ander gebet vorderde. Ein ider wert de gebede ordenen na gelegenheit, dat nicht stedes ein collecte gelesen werde. Ock nicht in dem osterfeste, de collecten van den winachten, sonder ordentlick hir mede handelen, wo truwen husholderen to behort.

One shall also read but one collect at a time, unless it were that some other great need were at hand which required yet another prayer. Each shall order the prayers according to the occasion, that not always the same collect be read; nor at the feast of Easter the collects of Christmas; but [each shall] deal herein in order, as becometh faithful stewards.

**Two collects as the rule: Ansbach 1548.** The Ansbach *Auctuarium* of 1548, an Interim order, goes back to the medieval pattern of a collect of the day followed by a second, votive collect. It requires two, and fixes their subjects: the first for spiritual things, the second for temporal goods. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

> Auf solch gesang volgen in der kirchenordnung etlich viel gestelte collecten oder gebet, daraus jedesmals zwo collecten nach gelegenhait der zeit für allerlei anligen der christenhait und des volks genommen werden solln. Doch das die erste collect allwegen für gaistliche sachen sei und die ander umb zeitliche gueter als frid, gut wetter, für die frucht des feldes etc., allerding, wie in der kirchenordnung vermeldet wurd.

After such singing there follow in the church order very many collects or prayers set forth, out of which each time two collects shall be taken according to the occasion of the time, for all manner of concerns of Christendom and of the people; yet so that the first collect be always for spiritual things, and the second for temporal goods, as peace, good weather, for the fruit of the field, etc., altogether as is set forth in the church order.

**"One or more."** Other orders leave the number open:

- **Henneberg**: a pastor's report has "a collect or two, as need requireth" after the sermon (Sehling 2, p. 330).
- **Wolfstein 1574**: "one or more collects according to the occasion of the time etc., and these shall be in German and not Latin" (Sehling 13, p. 576).

**The second collect for peace.** The commonest second prayer is the collect for peace. Luther's *Verleih uns Frieden* was sung at the end of the service with a German collect after it, "Herr Gott, himlischer Vater, der du heiligen Mut, guten Rat und rechte Werke schaffst …". This is the Missal collect of the Mass for peace, *Deus, a quo sancta desideria, recta consilia, et iusta sunt opera* (Sehling 6/2, p. 819, n. 71). It appears in at least twelve orders of the corpus, from Saxony 1539 to Schaumburg 1614. In Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 it follows the proper postcommunion, so that the Advent Mass ends with two collects, the proper one and the one for peace (§5.6.2).

**Hof 1592: "of the season, or for rain".** At Vespers the Hof deacon sings "the collect of the season, or also for rain and fair weather" (Sehling 11, p. 429). The votive collects *ad petendam pluviam* and *ad poscendam serenitatem* of the Missal survive here by name.

#### 5.4.2 The collect of the day kept, in German

**Saxony 1539.** The order of Duke Henry has the collect "in Latin or German, the common one or *quotidianam*, or *de festis*, as they stand hereafter at the end". **Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 274):

> Darnach eine collecten, auch latinisch oder deudsch, die gemeine oder quotidianam, oder de festis, wie sie hernach zu end stehen.

Thereafter a collect, also in Latin or German, the common one or [the] daily one, or [one] of the feasts, as they stand hereafter at the end.

The collects at the end are headed "collects or prayers which one may read in the church under the office of the Mass (before the epistle) and also otherwise" (Sehling 1, p. 275). They are grouped by season: Advent, Christmas, and so on.

**Collect series by the church year.** The later territorial orders print a series of German collects for the seasons and feasts:

- **Saxony 1580** and **Mansfeld 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 375; 2, pp. 227–229);
- **Lüneburg 1564** and **Wolfenbüttel 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 568–572 and 178–179);
- **Henneberg 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 317);
- **Grubenhagen 1581** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1076–1081);
- **Verden 1606** and **Osnabrück 1618** (Sehling 7/1), **Oldenburg 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1) and **Schaumburg 1614** (Sehling 7/2.2).

Henneberg introduces its series as "pure collects", partly in use before, partly new. **Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 317):

> Volgen die collecten, nach ordnung der zeit und festen im jar. Auf das die pfarrherrn und kirchendiener die versikel und reine collecten beisamen haben mögen, ist fur gut angesehen worden, dieselben hiernach zu setzen. Und sind solche gutes teils hiebevor auch, ausserhalb etlicher, welche zum teil nach gelegenheit dieser ordnung und dann auch sonsten von neuem hinzugesetzt worden, in unserer kirchen gebreuchlich gewesen, und erstlich die, so auf gewise fest und zeiten, volgends andere gemeine, so nach gelegenheit jeder vorfallender not und sonsten pflegen gesungen zu werden.

Here follow the collects, according to the order of the seasons and feasts in the year. That the pastors and ministers of the church may have the versicles and pure collects together, it hath been thought good to set them down hereafter. And such have for a good part been in use in our churches heretofore also, except some which have been newly added, partly by occasion of this order and partly otherwise; and first those [appointed] for certain feasts and seasons, then other common ones, which are wont to be sung according to the occasion of every need that falleth out, and otherwise.

**The proper collect kept with its versicle.** Henneberg's "versicles and pure collects" keep another medieval habit: the collect introduced by a seasonal versicle. Its Advent set begins "Bereitet den weg dem herrn, halleluja" (Sehling 2, p. 317). Hof 1592 does the same before its festal collects ("Uns ist ein kind geboren", Sehling 11, p. 413).

**What the German collects are.** Sehling's editors trace most of the seasonal collects of the Saxon and Lower Saxon series back to the **Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533**, and through it to the Missal. Lüneburg's Advent collect is a typical case. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 542–543):

> Darauf wende sich der priester widerumb jegen den altar und singe eine collecten de tempore oder festo oder die sich zu der materien schicken auf folgende melodey: […] Last uns beten: Allmechtiger Herre Gott, weck uns auf, das wir bereit sein, wenn […] dein Son kümpt, ihn mit freuden zu empfahen und dir mit reinem herzen zu dienen durch denselbigen deinen Son Jhesum Christum, unsern Herrn.

Thereupon let the priest turn again toward the altar and sing a collect of the season or of the feast, or one that agreeth with the matter, to the following melody: […] Let us pray. Almighty Lord God, stir us up, that we may be ready, when thy Son cometh, to receive him with joy and to serve thee with a pure heart; through the same thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

This is the Advent collect *Excita, Domine, corda nostra ad praeparandas Unigeniti tui vias: ut per eius adventum purificatis tibi mentibus servire mereamur*. Sehling's editors identify it as the collect of the second Sunday in Advent (Sehling 6/2, p. 1077, n. 86; 7/1, p. 93, n. 7). "Mit reinem herzen zu dienen" is *purificatis mentibus servire*. The Missal's "prepare the ways of thine Only-begotten" becomes "that we may be ready … to receive him with joy". The same collect stands in Saxony 1580, Mansfeld 1580, Grubenhagen 1581, Buxtehude 1565 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1588.

**Other Missal collects identified by the editors.** In the notes to Lüneburg, Grubenhagen, Osnabrück and Oldenburg the editors identify, among others:

- Christmas: *Concede, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, ut nos Unigeniti tui nova per carnem nativitas liberet* (third Mass of Christmas; Sehling 7/1, p. 271; 7/2.1, p. 1134);
- Ascension: *Concede, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, ut qui hodierna die Unigenitum tuum … ad caelos ascendisse credimus* (Sehling 6/2, p. 1078, n. 97);
- Pentecost: *Deus, qui hodierna die corda fidelium Sancti Spiritus illustratione docuisti* (Sehling 6/2, p. 1079, n. 99);
- the third Sunday after Easter (Sehling 6/1, p. 573, n. 76).

Pentecost is identified in Osnabrück too (Sehling 7/1, p. 275). The introduction to the Oldenburg order sums up its very large collection: of all its collects only two are its own, and of these "the one rests upon a Latin Mass prayer" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 962).

#### 5.4.3 The collects purged

**"If it be pure."** The condition Luther set ("if only it be godly") recurs:

- **Amberg 1550**: "the collect of the season, if it be pure, and the epistle in Latin" (Sehling 13, p. 286).
- **Henneberg 1582**: "pure collects" (above).

**Collects removed.** The collects that went were those of the saints, and above all those that asked for the intercession of Mary and the saints. Hannover 1536 names them with the Marian antiphons. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1009):

> Was wider Gottes wort ist, lassen wir nimer singen oder lesen, es sey deudsch oder latin. Darumb haben wir abgestelt das Salve regina, Regina celi, Sub tuum presidium und etliche collecten, darinnen die ehre, so allein unserm einigen mitler Jhesu Christo zugehört, allzu grob den creaturn zugelegt wird.

Whatsoever is against God's word we will never suffer to be sung or read, be it German or Latin. Therefore we have put away the Salve regina, the Regina caeli, the Sub tuum praesidium, and certain collects wherein the honour that belongeth to our one Mediator Jesus Christ alone is all too grossly given to the creatures.

**Luther on the office collects.** Already in 1523 Luther had set aside the antiphons, responsories and collects "of the saints and of the cross" until "they be swept", "for there is grievous much filth therein" (Sehling 1, p. 3).

#### 5.4.4 New collects added: the gospel collects

**Veit Dietrich's collects.** The chief addition was a new kind of collect: one written on the **gospel of the day**, as a summary of the sermon, rather than on the season. The source was Veit Dietrich's *Kinderpostille* and *Summarien* (from 1546). Wolfenbüttel 1569 allows them in place of the season's collect. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 179):

> Es mögen auch zu zeiten auf den Sontagen und feirtagen die collecten accommodiret werden auf die lehre, so aus dem evangelio gehandelt wird, wie solche collecten in der kinderpostillen Viti Didrichs zu finden sind.

There may also at times on the Sundays and holy days the collects be accommodated to the doctrine that is handled out of the gospel, as such collects are to be found in the children's postil of Veit Dietrich.

Other orders allow the same:

- **Lippe, Corvinus's order of 1542**: a later hand adds that "there stand also certain fine collects in the postil of Veit Dietrich, appointed for all Sundays and feasts" (Sehling 21, p. 352, apparatus).

- **Soest 1609**: "a collect … that agreeth with the gospel, or else a common collect for the grace of the Holy Ghost for the sermon" (Sehling 22, p. 488).
- **Lüneburg 1564**: "or one that agreeth with the matter" (above).

**Two collects again: one before and one after the sermon.** In the Buxtehude agenda of 1565 each Sunday has two collects, the old and the new. Sehling's introduction describes the arrangement. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565, editor's introduction** (Sehling 7/1, p. 67):

> In der ersten Kollektensammlung für die Sonn- und Festtage des Jahres wechselt meistens ein dem Missale entlehntes, freilich ins Niederdeutsche und teilweise sehr frei übertragenes Gebet mit einer Evangelienkollekte Veit Dietrichs, wobei das eine Gebet vor, das andere nach der Predigt zu sprechen ist. Diesem Kollektenzyklus liegt eine in verschiedenen Ausgaben erschienene Sammlung des Mansfelder Hofpredigers Michael Coelius (1492-1559) zugrunde. Eine zweite Kollektensammlung gegen Schluß der Agende stellt alte lateinische Meßgebete, stellenweise etwas überarbeitet, zusammen.

In the first collection of collects for the Sundays and feasts of the year there alternate for the most part a prayer borrowed from the Missal (rendered, indeed, into Low German and in part very freely) and a gospel collect of Veit Dietrich, the one prayer to be said before the sermon and the other after it. Underlying this cycle of collects is a collection by the Mansfeld court preacher Michael Coelius (1492–1559), which appeared in various editions. A second collection of collects toward the end of the agenda brings together old Latin Mass prayers, here and there somewhat revised.

An example of the Missal collect "before the sermon" is that of the third Sunday after Epiphany, *Omnipotens sempiterne Deus, infirmitatem nostram propitius respice, atque ad protegendum nos dexteram tuae maiestatis extende*. Sehling's note cites the Verden Missal for it (Sehling 7/1, p. 98, n. 62). **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 98):

> Am drudden Sondag. Gebett vor der predig. Almechtige Herr Godt, du woldest gnedichlick behertigen unsere swackheit und dyne gewaldigen hand utrecken, uns vor unsern vienden to schutten, dorch Jhesum Christum, unsern Hern. Amen.

On the third Sunday. Prayer before the sermon. Almighty Lord God, mayest thou graciously take to heart our weakness, and stretch forth thy mighty hand to defend us against our enemies; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

**Michael Coelius.** The editors name the source of many of these German Missal collects: the collection of the Mansfeld court preacher **Michael Coelius**, who "translated a Latin Mass prayer into German for his collection of collects" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1137, n. 35; 7/1, p. 92, n. 1). The old proper collects thus came into the Lutheran orders by two routes. The first was Luther's circle and the Wittenberg hymnbooks (1529–1533). The second was Coelius's translations.

#### 5.4.5 Language, voice and form

**Latin or German.** The early orders allowed either:

- **Bremen 1534**: "a collect in Latin out of the Mass book, or in German out of the hymnbook" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 459);
- **Saxony 1539**: "also in Latin or German" (above);
- **Amberg 1550**: the collect of the season, in Latin (above).

Later orders required German, so that the people could say the Amen. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation of 1554/55** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

> Zum dritten, das keine collecten lateinisch, sondern alle sampt deutsch gesungen werden, dormit das volk vorstehen und amen dorzu singen moge.

Thirdly, that no collects be sung in Latin, but all together in German, that the people may understand, and sing Amen thereto.

Wolfstein 1574 says the same ("in German and not Latin", Sehling 13, p. 576). Mecklenburg 1545 has the collect read "with a loud voice, that the whole church may say Amen and so cry unto God with the priest" (Sehling 5, p. 152).

**Facing the altar.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* has the collect read "with the face turned to the altar", the epistle "with the face turned to the people" (Sehling 1, p. 14). Lüneburg 1564 keeps the rule (above). Hof 1592 has the deacon sing the collect "facing the people" (*spectans populum*, Sehling 11, p. 425).

**The conclusions.** Hof 1592 keeps the medieval rules for ending a collect, set out as in the old rubrics. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

> Notio de collectis! Quandocunque oratio dirigitur ad Patrem solum, in fine dicatur: Per Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum etc. Si vero dirigitur ad Patrem et Filii mentio fit in ipsa, in fine dicatur: per eundem Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum. Si oratio dirigitur ad Filium solum, finis sic formetur: Qui cum Patre et Spiritu Sancto vivis et regnas Deus per omnia etc.

A note on the collects! Whensoever the prayer is directed to the Father alone, let there be said at the end: Through our Lord Jesus Christ, etc. But if it be directed to the Father, and mention of the Son be made in it, let there be said at the end: through the same our Lord Jesus Christ. If the prayer be directed to the Son alone, let the ending be formed thus: Who with the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest, God, world without end, etc.

**Hof's collects at Mass.** At the Mass itself Hof's deacon sings "the collect of the season, or one directed to the Lord's Supper". After the communion he sings "a collect, for example the thanksgiving for the Lord's Supper received" (Sehling 11, pp. 425–426). Its example of a Mass collect is the *Deutsche Messe* collect "O allmechtiger Gott, der du bist ein beschützer aller" (Sehling 11, p. 425).

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## 5.5 The secret

### 5.5.1 Abolished with the offertory

**No order keeps the secret as a prayer over the gifts.** The secret was the offertory's own prayer: it asked God to receive the gifts offered. Luther's rejection of the offertory (§5.3.2) took it with it, and the orders that name the secret do so only to say it is left out:

- **Volprecht, 1524**: "the offertory is never said, because Christ was once offered for our sins" (Sehling 11, p. 39). There is no secret in his list.
- **The Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524**: after the Creed the celebrant goes straight to *Dominus vobiscum* and *Sursum corda*, "the offertory and the lesser canon being omitted" (*offertorio ac canone minore omissis*, Sehling 11, p. 47).
- **Prussia 1525** names the secret outright. **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchenordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Volgt die prefation, welche der priester deütsch singet samt den evangelischen worten der gebenedeiung oder consecration oder brod und wein (den offertorium, secret, canon minor und maior werden notwendig ausgelassen).

There followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German, together with the evangelical words of the blessing or consecration of bread and wine (for the offertory, the secret, the lesser and the greater canon are of necessity left out).

**Never a German secret.** The Lutheran orders translated collects and postcommunions from the Missal, but the corpus has no German version of any secret. The secrets were the prayers that most plainly asked God to accept an offering. Unlike the collects, they could not be "purified" by a light change of wording.

### 5.5.2 What took the secret's place

**Its last words.** The secret ended aloud with *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, which ran straight into *Dominus vobiscum* and *Sursum corda*. Three German Masses keep this ending before the Preface dialogue, though the silent prayer is gone:

- Müntzer (Radical Reformation): "durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen";
- Lippe: "Durch alle ewicheit der ewicheit amen";
- Calenberg-Göttingen 1542: "Gott sey preis von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen".

See Chapter 7, §7.1.1 and §7.4.1.

**An open prayer at the same place.** Dortmund 1554 keeps the heading *Secreta* and says what is to be done there instead. The silent prayer over the gifts becomes an open prayer for the magistrates and the needs of Christendom, if the general prayer has not already been said after the sermon. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554** (Sehling 21, p. 209):

> Secreta Vor de Secreta mach de Prester ein apen gebedt don vor alle Overicheit, stenden unde nodtsaken der gantzen Christenheit, dar he medde an de Prefation kome, so he na der predike dat gemene bedt nicht gedan hedde edder sus ein ander na gelegenheit der tydt.

Secret. In place of the Secret the priest may make an open prayer for all magistrates, estates and needs of the whole Christendom, wherewith he may come to the Preface, if he have not made the common prayer after the sermon; or else another, according to the occasion of the time.

**Collects under the Sanctus.** In several orders the space between the offertory and the Verba was filled with **collects said aloud** for the Church and the magistrates. They stood under the Sanctus, before or after the Verba:

- **Döber, Nürnberg 1525**: an optional "common prayer, to be said on a holy day when there is much people, after the Preface or before the Sanctus, as one will" (Sehling 11, p. 55). See Chapter 7, §7.8.11.
- **Brandenburg 1540**: four German collects under the Latin Sanctus (§7.12.2 of that chapter).
- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: "the collect which the priest prayeth under the Sanctus", headed "Für die oberkeit". It is printed in every proper Mass of the order: "Folget die collecten, welche der priester under dem Sanctus betet: Barmherziger himlischer Vater …" (Sehling 6/2, p. 819, and again in each proper Mass, pp. 821–833). See §7.13.1 of that chapter.
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: three collects under the Sanctus, after the Verba (§7.14.4 of that chapter).

These are not secrets. They are not proper to the day, they say nothing of gifts, and they are said aloud. But they occupy the secret's place, and like the medieval memorial collects they pray for the ruler and for peace.

**A prayer over the gifts, once.** Only Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has a prayer said over the bread and wine before the Verba: Osiander's "Wir bringen … dise deine gaben". It is a new composition, not a secret. See Chapter 7, §7.14.2.

**In sum.** Of the three proper prayers the secret alone vanished without a successor of its own kind. What survives is its closing doxology, its place (filled with intercessions), and in one order its name.

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## 5.6 The postcommunion

### 5.6.1 Luther's 1523 substitutes: *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum*

**In Latin.** Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 keep both of Luther's prayers in Latin. The priest says them "bowing", after the German thanksgiving (Sehling 3, p. 70; 13, p. 76). The texts are given in Chapter 7, §7.12.8 and §7.14.8. Here they have become the priest's own devotion again, said after the people's thanksgiving, which is what they had been in the Roman rite.

**In German.** The Strasbourg Mass of Theobald Schwarz (1524, Moderate Reformed) gives *Quod ore sumpsimus* in German under the old name *Complenda*. It also allows "any other that seemeth Christian". **Strasbourg, the early agendas: Schwarz's German Mass, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 123):

> Complenda Laßt uns bitten: Das wir mit mund haben zu uns genomen, verlyhe uns, herr, uff das wir dasselbig mit reynem gemüt annemen, und das uns von der zeytlichen goben werde eyne ewige artzenyg, durch Christum Jesum, unsern herrn, Amen. Vel aliam aliquam, que Christiana videtur.

Complenda. Let us pray. What we have taken with our mouth, grant us, O Lord, that we may receive the same with a pure mind; and that from the temporal gift there may be made unto us an everlasting medicine; through Christ Jesus our Lord. Amen. Or some other that seemeth Christian.

The printed *Teutsche Meß* of 1524 has the same text (Sehling 20/1, p. 133). The Strasbourg *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess* (also Moderate Reformed) explains the term for the people: "Complenda: the conclusion with a common prayer" (Sehling 20/1, p. 135). Volprecht's German Mass has a German *Quod ore* too (Chapter 7, §7.7.2).

### 5.6.2 Proper postcommunions kept

**Not every early order followed Luther.** Several kept the proper *complenda* of the day, either in Latin or in a German version.

**Nürnberg, 1524.** The Latin Mass of the Nürnberg parish churches ends with the day's postcommunion. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 49):

> Demum offitium cum oratione, quam complendam vocant, concludatur.

Finally let the office be concluded with the prayer which they call the complenda.

The Coburg proposal of 1524, which follows the Nürnberg Mass ("the offertory and the lesser canon left out"), likewise ends with "the collect which they call the complenda, and the Benedicamus with the blessing, as is customary" (Sehling 1, p. 542).

**Volprecht, 1524.** Volprecht's outline of the Latin Mass has "*Complenda de quo sit missa*": the postcommunion of whatever Mass is being said (Sehling 11, p. 39). Sehling's note: "namely the one falling due in each case". His German Mass for Trinity ends with the Trinity postcommunion, *Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae*, in German (Sehling 11, p. 42). See Chapter 7, §7.7.2.

**Müntzer, 1524** (Radical Reformation). Each of Müntzer's five German Masses ends with a "prayer at the end of the office", most of them German versions of the Missal postcommunion. For Easter it is the Easter postcommunion, *Spiritum nobis, Domine, tuae caritatis infunde: ut quos sacramentis paschalibus satiasti, tua facias pietate concordes*. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch messe*, 1524** (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 503):

> Unser osterlamp Christus ist geopfert vor uns alleluia alleluia. […] Gepet am ende des ampts der ersteung. O herr geuss in uns den geist der liebe und die du hast gesettiget mit deinem osterlamb mache eintrechtig in deiner liebe durch Jesum etc.

Christ our Passover is sacrificed for us, alleluia, alleluia. […] Prayer at the end of the office of the Resurrection. O Lord, pour into us the spirit of love, and those whom thou hast filled with thine Easter lamb make of one mind in thy love; through Jesus, etc.

The other postcommunions of Müntzer's Masses (Radical Reformation):

- **Pentecost**: *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio* ("O herr vorlei uns die gnad des heiligen geists, auf das der thau deiner güte …", Sehling 1, p. 504).
- **Advent**: a new prayer, "O herr gott, steh hart bei uns" (Chapter 7, §7.4.4).
- **Christmas and the Passion**: prayers in the same form, "O gütiger gott eröffne uns den abgrund unser selen …" and "O herr gib deinem armen volke zu erkennen deine veterliche zucht und ruthe …" (Sehling 1, p. 502). This chapter has not found a Missal source for them.

**Erfurt, 1525.** The Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* takes over the offices of Müntzer (Radical Reformation) and adds one for Trinity. Its "prayer at the end of the office" is the Trinity postcommunion *Proficiat*. **Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525** (Sehling 2, p. 378):

> Gebet am ende des ampts: O herre got, lass uns zu nutz kummen des leibes und der seelen die entphahunge des heiligen sacraments und das ewige bekentnus des [der] heiligen und der selbstendigen, ungetheilten dreivaltigkeit. Der du lebest und regirest, got, mit dem son und heiligem geiste von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen.

Prayer at the end of the office: O Lord God, let the receiving of the holy sacrament profit us for body and soul, and the everlasting confession of the holy and self-subsistent, undivided Trinity. Who livest and reignest, God, with the Son and the Holy Ghost, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

The Latin is *Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae, Domine Deus noster, huius sacramenti susceptio: et sempiterna sanctae Trinitatis eiusdemque individuae Unitatis confessio*. Erfurt's Pentecost office has Müntzer's Pentecost postcommunion (Sehling 2, p. 377).

**Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542.** The fullest survival is in the Calenberg-Göttingen order. Its proper Masses for Advent, Christmas, Purification, the Passion, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost each have, in order:

1. the collect of the day after the Gloria;
2. a collect for the magistrates under the Sanctus (§5.5.2);
3. in every Mass but Advent, a fixed thanksgiving after the communion ("Die danksagung"), usually Luther's;
4. after the *Agnus Dei*, a second, **proper** postcommunion, headed "Die collecta". Some are Missal postcommunions, others collects from the Wittenberg hymnbook (Passion, Sehling 6/2, p. 827).

Sehling's editors identify several of these proper prayers as Missal postcommunions. The Advent Mass, which has no thanksgiving, ends with the proper postcommunion and then the *Da pacem* with its collect: two collects after the communion, the proper one and the one for peace, as in the medieval rite. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Advent** (Sehling 6/2, p. 819):

> Collect. Herre, las uns entpfangen an mittel des tempels deine barmherzigkeit, auf das wir mit billicher ehr vorgehen der herrligkeit, die an jenem tage uber uns komen wird. Das Da paoem zum beschlus: [...] Verley uns friden gnediglich, Herr Gott, zu unsern zeiten, es ist doch ja kein ander nicht, der fur uns künde streiten, denn du, unser Gott, alleine. Gott, gib frid in deinem lande! Glück und heil zu allem stande! Herr Gott, himlischer Vater, der du heiligen muth, guten rath und rechte werke schaffest, gib deinen dienern frid, welchen die welt nicht kan geben, auf das unsere herzen an deinen geboten hangen und wir unsere zeit durch deinen schutz still und sicher fur feinden leben durch Jhesum Christ, deinen Sohn, unsern Herren. Amen.

Collect. Lord, let us receive thy mercy in the midst of thy temple, that we may go before the glory which shall come upon us at that day with fitting honour. The *Da pacem* for the conclusion: [...] Grant us peace graciously, Lord God, in our days; there is indeed none other that could fight for us but thou, our God, alone. God, give peace in thy land! Fortune and welfare to every estate! Lord God, heavenly Father, who workest holy desire, good counsel and right works, give unto thy servants peace, which the world cannot give, that our hearts may cleave to thy commandments, and that we may pass our time by thy defence quiet and safe from enemies; through Jesus Christ, thy Son, our Lord. Amen.

The first prayer is the postcommunion of the first Sunday in Advent: *Suscipiamus, Domine, misericordiam tuam in medio templi tui: ut reparationis nostrae ventura solemnia congruis honoribus praecedamus*. Sehling's note gives the Latin phrase *in medio templi tui* (Sehling 6/2, p. 819, nn. 69–69a). The German changes "the coming solemnities of our redemption" into "the glory which shall come upon us at that day", turning the prayer from Christmas to the Last Day. The peace collect is the Missal's *Deus, a quo sancta desideria* (n. 71).

**The Easter Mass of the same order** has, after Luther's thanksgiving and the *Agnus Dei*, a version of the Easter postcommunion. It is shorter and freer than Müntzer's. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, Easter** (Sehling 6/2, p. 829):

> Die danksagung. Wir danken dir, almechtiger Gott .... [...] Das Agnus Dei. O lamb Gottes unschuldig ... [...] Herr, uberschütte uns mit deinem Geiste, das wir in steter liebe und einigkeit leben, deiner auferstehung und zukunft niemer vergessen. Amen. Die benedictio. Der Herr segne dich ....

The thanksgiving. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty God ... [...] The Agnus Dei. O Lamb of God, unspotted ... [...] Lord, pour out upon us thy Spirit, that we may live in constant love and concord, and never forget thy resurrection and thy coming again. Amen. The blessing. The Lord bless thee ...

Sehling's note: "On the following prayer compare the Roman Missal ... (postcommunion on Easter Sunday and Easter Monday)" (Sehling 6/2, p. 829, n. 37a). The order's Pentecost Mass has the Pentecost postcommunion of Müntzer (Radical Reformation) in the same place (Sehling 6/2, p. 834). The order's common Mass, used outside the feasts, has in this slot the priest's prayer for peace *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* in German. See Chapter 7, §7.13.3.

**Where the line ends.** Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 is the last order in the corpus to print proper postcommunions for the feasts. After it the proper postcommunion is gone from the Mass. Some of these prayers survived as collects for other uses: the Corpus Christi collect became an alternative postcommunion (§5.6.4), and the Easter prayer for love and concord passed into the German collect books.

**A note on the Common Service.** The modern Common Service tradition, with its Sarum-derived postcommunion beside Luther's, lies outside the corpus, which ends in the early seventeenth century. Two things in the corpus bear on it:

- The **Easter postcommunion *Spiritum nobis ... tuae caritatis infunde*** is one of the Missal postcommunions that evangelical orders put into German and used after the communion: first Müntzer (Radical Reformation), then the Lutheran Calenberg-Göttingen.
- The Sarum and Roman Missals share most of their collects and postcommunions. The corpus therefore cannot show whether a given prayer reached a later book from the Sarum or the Roman Missal. The German orders took theirs from the German diocesan Missals.

### 5.6.3 Luther's thanksgiving becomes the ordinary postcommunion

**From 1526 on.** Luther's thanksgiving "Wir danken dir, allmächtiger Herr Gott, dass du uns durch diese heilsame Gabe hast erquicket" (§5.3.3) became the standard postcommunion of the Lutheran orders. The editor of the Verden order lists where it stands (Sehling 7/1, p. 161, n. 81):

- Lüneburg and Wolfenbüttel;
- Lippe, Spiegelberg and Pyrmont 1571;
- Oldenburg 1573;
- Grubenhagen and Hoya 1581;
- Lauenburg;
- Osnabrück 1618;
- and, he adds, "elsewhere also widely spread".

To these the corpus adds Saxony 1539 and 1580, Mansfeld 1580, Prussia 1544, Mecklenburg 1545, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hatzkerode, Nördlingen 1579 and others.

**Still called the *complenda*.** Some orders keep the old name for the new prayer. The Hatzkerode order calls Luther's thanksgiving "the complenda". **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

> sol er sich umb keren und die salutatio singen: Der herr sei mit euch, dann wider zum altar gewant, die complende: Wir danken dir cet. oder dergleichen; zuletzt sol er sich wieder umb wenden und den segen singen: Der herr segne dich cet.

he shall turn about and sing the salutation, The Lord be with you; then, turned again to the altar, the complenda: We give thanks unto thee, etc., or the like; and last he shall turn about again and sing the blessing, The Lord bless thee, etc.

The term occurs also in Reuss 1552 ("the complenda after the use of our church … which one singeth toward the people", Sehling 2, p. 154), in Breslau 1550 ("then one readeth the complenda", Sehling 3, p. 404) and in the Wendish service at Senftenberg 1555 ("together with the complenda and the Aaronic blessing", Sehling 1, p. 672). Other orders call it simply "a collect of thanksgiving" (*eine Collecten thor danckseggínge*, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Sehling 23, p. 91).

**The salutation and the "Let us give thanks".** The thanksgiving keeps the frame of the old postcommunion: *Dominus vobiscum*, *Oremus*, the prayer, *Amen*. Two orders add a bidding to give thanks:

- **Mecklenburg 1545**: "Segget dank dem heren. Darup antwordet de kercke: Gade si loff unde dank" (Sehling 5, p. 155);
- **Saxony 1580**: "Last uns dem herrn danken und beten" (below).

Nördlingen 1579 puts a **versicle** before each, as before a medieval collect: 1 Cor 11:26 ("So oft ir von disem brot esset …") before Luther's thanksgiving, and 1 Cor 11:27 before the alternative. It appoints them for Palm Sunday and Maundy Thursday, "and also all Sundays and holy days after the communion held" (Sehling 12, p. 382).

### 5.6.4 The alternatives

**The ordinary was not alone.** Most orders print Luther's thanksgiving with one or two alternatives, "or this". The alternatives come from four sources.

**(a) The Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533.** Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 orders "a common prayer in German, spoken openly", which "shall be a thanksgiving". It is a new composition, longer than Luther's, and asks that what was received with the mouth be grasped by faith. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 197):

> Wann nun das volk alles verricht ist, soll man aber ein gemain gebet in teutsch offenlich sprechen. Das soll ein danksagung sein also: Laßt uns bitten! O almechtiger, ewiger Got. Wir sagen deiner götlichen miltigkeit lob und dank, das du uns mit dem hailsamen flaisch und blut deines ainigen Suns Jesu Christi, unsers Herrn, gespeist und getrenkt hast, und bitten dich demütiglich, du wöllest durch deinen Heiligen Gaist in uns würken, wie wir dis heilig sacrament mit dem mund haben empfangen, das wir auch also dein götliche gnad, vergebung der sünde, verainigung mit Christo und ewigs leben, so darinnen angezaigt und zugesagt ist, mit festem glauben mögen begreifen und ewiglich behalten. Durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, deinen Sun, der mit dir in ainigkeit des Heiligen Gaists lebt und herschet, warer Gott, immer und ewiglich. Amen.

Now when all the people have been communicated, there shall again be spoken openly a common prayer in German. This shall be a thanksgiving, thus: Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Ghost, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith lay hold on and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein shown forth and promised. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee in the unity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and everlastingly. Amen.

The phrase "as we have received … with the mouth, so … with firm faith" is Luther's *Quod ore sumpsimus … pura mente capiamus* opened out. The 1533 prayer is thus the third stage of the 1523 substitute: Latin ablution prayer, then plain German, then a doctrinal expansion.

**(b) Two collects "under one conclusion".** Brandenburg 1540 joins the Nürnberg prayer and Luther's into a single "thanksgiving" (Sehling 3, p. 70). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 does the same and names the old technique: two collects sung "under one conclusion", the way the medieval rite joined a postcommunion and a commemoration. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 76):

> Darnach soll er dise zwo collecten unter einem beschluß in gewonlichem ton singen oder mit vernemlicher stimme sprechen. Laßt uns beten: O almechtiger, ewiger Gott. Wir sagen deiner götlichen miltigkeit lob und dank, das du uns mit dem heilsamen fleisch und blut deines einigen Sons Jesu Christi, unsers Herrn, gespeiset und getrenket hast […]. Ein ander gebet. Wir danken dir auch, Herr Jesu Christe, das du uns durch dise heilsame gabe deines leibs und bluts hast erquicket, und bitten deine barmherzigkeit, das du uns solchs gedeihen lassest zu einem starken glauben gegen dir und zu brünstiger lieb unter uns allen, der du mit Got dem Vater in einigkeit des Heiligen Geists lebest und regirest immer und ewiglich. Chorus: Amen.

Thereafter he shall sing these two collects under one conclusion in the accustomed tone, or say them with an audible voice. Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord […]. Another prayer. We thank thee also, Lord Jesus Christ, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto a strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and everlastingly. Choir: Amen.

Pfalz-Neuburg addresses Luther's prayer to **Christ** ("Herr Jesu Christe") and closes it with the conclusion for a prayer to the Son. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 has the same two-part thanksgiving in its common Mass, "which shall be made in all Masses after the communion" (Sehling 6/2, p. 816; see Chapter 7, §7.13.3). Oldenburg 1573 gives the Nürnberg prayer as an alternative (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1145).

**(c) The Corpus Christi collect.** The most widespread alternative is a German version of the collect of Corpus Christi, *Deus, qui nobis sub sacramento mirabili passionis tuae memoriam reliquisti: tribue, quaesumus, ita nos corporis et sanguinis tui sacra mysteria venerari, ut redemptionis tuae fructum in nobis iugiter sentiamus*. Sehling's editors trace it to the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1076, n. 81). The identification with the Missal collect is this chapter's. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 369):

> Nach der communion lese man der nachfolgenden collecten eine, und beschliesse mit der benediction. Collecten. Last uns dem herrn danken und beten. Wir danken dir allmechtiger herre gott, das du uns durch diese heilsame gaben hast erquicket, und bitten deine barmherzigkeit, das du uns solches gedeien lassest, zu starkem glauben gegen dir, und zu brünstiger liebe unter uns allen, durch Jesum Christum deinen sohn, unsern herrn, Antwort. Amen. Oder diese. Ach du lieber herre gott, der du uns bei diesem wunderbarlichen sacrament deines leidens zugedenken und predigen befohlen hast, verleihe uns, das wir solch deines leibes und bluts sacrament also mögen brauchen, das wir dein erlösung in uns teglich fruchtbarlich empfinden, Antwort. Amen.

After the communion let one of the following collects be read, and let him conclude with the blessing. Collects. Let us give thanks unto the Lord and pray. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through these salutary gifts; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord. Answer: Amen. Or this. O thou dear Lord God, who in this

wonderful sacrament hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion; grant us so to use this sacrament of thy body and blood, that we may daily perceive in us fruitfully thy redemption. Answer: Amen.

The Latin "hast left us a memorial of thy passion" becomes "hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion" (1 Cor 11:26). "To venerate the sacred mysteries" becomes "so to use this sacrament". The petition *ut redemptionis tuae fructum in nobis iugiter sentiamus* is kept almost word for word: "das wir dein erlösung in uns teglich fruchtbarlich empfinden". The same pair (Luther's, "or this" the Corpus Christi collect) stands in:

- Mecklenburg 1545 (below);
- Buxtehude 1565, where the Corpus Christi collect comes **first** (Sehling 7/1, p. 125);
- Mansfeld 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 227);
- Grubenhagen 1581 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1076);
- Oldenburg 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1145);
- Nördlingen 1579 (Sehling 12, p. 382).

Grubenhagen 1581 also uses it in its old place, as the collect for Maundy Thursday ("Die coenae Domini", Sehling 6/2, p. 1078). The Württemberg order of 1536 has it among its collects as the *Oratio de Eucharistia* (Sehling 16, p. 125).

**(d) Döber's prayer of 1525.** Döber's Nürnberg Mass of 1525 has a postcommunion that Sehling's editor thought "apparently newly made" (Sehling 11, p. 55, n. 22). **Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des A. Döber*, 1525** (Sehling 11, pp. 54–55):

> Darnach die collecten spricht zum volk: Last uns bitten: O Herr, allmechtiger Got, verleih uns in unser gemüt und herzen, das wir durch den zeitlichen tod [...] deines Suns, welche dise wirdige geheimnus bedeuten, das wir getrauen, das du uns geben hast das ewig leben durch den Christum, unsern Herrn. Amen.

Thereafter he saith the collect to the people: Let us pray. O Lord Almighty God, grant us in our minds and hearts that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which this worthy mystery signifieth, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Its pairing of "temporal" with "signifieth" and "everlasting" recalls the Corpus Christi postcommunion *Fac nos, quaesumus, Domine, divinitatis tuae sempiterna fruitione repleri: quam pretiosi Corporis et Sanguinis tui temporalis perceptio praefigurat*. It may be a free reworking of it; this is a suggestion, not Sehling's identification. Mecklenburg took Döber's prayer into its list of three.

**Mecklenburg's three.** Mecklenburg 1545 offers all three kinds: Luther's, Döber's, and the Corpus Christi collect. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 155):

> Darup de prester: Latet uns beden. Wi danken di allmechtige here godt, dat du uns dorch düsse heilsame gave dines lives unde blodes heffst erquicket, und bidden dine barmherticheit, dat du uns sülckes gedien latest to starkem loven jegen di, unde to füriger leve mank uns allen, dorch unsen heren Jesum Christum, amen. Edder to tiden dit gebet. O here almechtige vader vorlene uns in unse gemöte unde herte, dat wi dorch den tidtliken dot dines söns, welckeren düsse werdige hemelicheit bedüdet, getrüwen, dat du uns gegeven heffst dat ewige levent, dorch Jesum Christum, unsen heren, amen. Edder düsse. Ach du leve here godt, de du uns bi düssem wunderbarliken sacramente dines lidens to gedenken unde predigen bevalen heffst, vorlene uns, dat wi sölck dines lives unde blodes sacramente also mögen bruken, dat wi dine erlösinge in uns dagelick fruchtbarlick erfinden, dorch Jesum Christum, amen.

Thereupon the priest: Let us pray. We give thanks unto thee, Almighty Lord God, that thou hast refreshed us through this salutary gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy, that thou wouldest make the same to prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. Or at times this prayer: O Lord, almighty Father, grant us in our minds and hearts that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which this worthy mystery signifieth, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen. Or this: O thou dear Lord God, who by this wonderful sacrament hast commanded us to remember and to preach thy passion; grant us so to use this sacrament of thy body and blood, that we may daily perceive in us fruitfully thy redemption; through Jesus Christ. Amen.

**(e) Alternating Sundays: Prussia 1544.** The Prussian order of 1544 has two postcommunions sung "to alternate every other Sunday". The second is a new prayer on the fruit of the passion. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 66):

> Darnach wendet sich der priester zum volk und singt: Der herre sei mit euch, und wendet sich widder noch dem altar, singt der collecten eine mit gewönlichem accent etc. umb den andern soutag abzuwechseln. Erste collect. Wir danken dir etc. […] Ein ander collect. O warhaftiger got, barmherziger vater, wir bitten dich herzlich, las uns dürftigen des heiligen leidens unsers herren nutz und frucht, das ist gnade und vergebung unser sünden mit gleubigem herzen rechtschaffen ergreifen, gleich wie wir durch deines heiligen sones wort seinen heiligen leib und sein theures blut, welche er für uns gegeben und vergossen hat, unter dem brot und wein warlich haben empfangen, durch denselbigen unsern herren Jesum Christum, deinen sohn, der mit dir lebet und hirschet von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen.

Thereafter the priest turneth to the people and singeth: The Lord be with you; and turneth again to the altar, [and] singeth one of the collects with the customary accent, etc., to alternate every other Sunday. First collect: We give thanks unto thee, etc. […] Another collect: O true God, merciful Father, we heartily beseech thee, let us needy ones rightly lay hold with believing heart on the profit and fruit of the holy passion of our Lord, that is, grace and the forgiveness of our sins, even as through the word of thy holy Son we have truly received under the bread and wine his holy body and his precious blood, which he gave and shed for us; through the same our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who liveth and reigneth with thee from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

The Prussian articles of 1525 had already provided "two common collects or complendas for the end of the Mass, to alternate through the whole year". Sehling does not print them (Sehling 4, p. 37).

**(f) Later replacements.** Late orders sometimes replace Luther's short prayer with a longer one. At Engerhafe in East Frisia (1583) "a trinitarian thanksgiving has taken the place of Luther's short thanksgiving collect (postcommunion)", as Sehling's editor notes in comparing it with the order of 1535 (Sehling 7/1, p. 681, n. 34). The thanksgiving with the *Placeat* in Kantz's Mass of 1522 is treated in Chapter 7, §7.2.7.

#### 5.6.5 When there was no communion

**A collect instead.** Without communicants the Lutheran Mass ended after the sermon, and the postcommunion slot was filled with "a collect" of the pastor's choice, not with the thanksgiving for the sacrament:

- **Saxony 1580**: "But where no communicants are present, it shall be concluded after the sermon, or a chapter of Holy Scripture read, with a Christian collect and the customary blessing" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Soest 1609**: "When there are no communicants, the preacher may conclude with a collect of his own choice" (*arbitraria collecta*, Sehling 22, p. 495).
- **Lippe 1571**: a collect "or thanksgiving for the word of God heard". **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 397):

> Darauff eine Collecten oder Dancksagung für das gehörte Wort Gottes singen und mit einem Christlichen Liede beschliessen.

Thereupon sing a collect or thanksgiving for the word of God which hath been heard, and conclude with a Christian hymn.

The thanksgiving for the gift of the sacrament became, in the service without communion, a thanksgiving for the gift of the Word.

The service when nobody communicated is treated in Chapter 2, §2.14, and the Litany sung in place of the Mass in Chapter 13, §13.22.1.

#### 5.6.6 The prayer over the people (*oratio super populum*)

**The medieval use.** On the weekdays of Lent the Missal added a fourth proper prayer after the postcommunion. The deacon bade the people *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*, "Bow down your heads before God", and the priest said the *oratio super populum*, a prayer over the people, before the dismissal. In the Breviary the same prayers served as collects of the office on the Lenten weekdays.

**Not at the Mass.** No Lutheran order in the corpus keeps the *super populum* at the end of the Mass. The bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo* does not occur, in Latin or in German. The corpus was searched for *super populum*, *super plebem*, *humiliate capita*, *inclinate capita* and German phrases such as "neiget eure Häupter". The Lutheran Mass had no weekday Lenten Masses to carry the prayer. Its place at the end of the Sunday Mass was held by the postcommunion collect and the Aaronic blessing. The orders describe that blessing in the same words: "the blessing over the people out of the book of Numbers" (*benediction*

*uber das volk aus dem buch numeri*, Gnandstein 1539, Sehling 1, p. 564). Müntzer (Radical Reformation) describes his postcommunion the same way: "after the communion one giveth thanks to God over the people, and blesseth the Lord" (Sehling 1, p. 506). Neither is a *super populum* prayer.

**In the office: Ansbach 1533.** The one place where the *super populum* survives by name is in the Divine Office of the collegiate churches. The Brandenburg-Ansbach order of 1533 for the singing and reading in the *Stifte* goes through the Breviary and strikes out what is unfit. In Lent it strikes out the collects at Lauds (*super Benedictus*) that "speak of the fast" as a work, day by day. For their place it allows the *super populum* prayers. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 315):

> In die Cinerum collecta super Benedictus Concede nobis, Domine praesidia und andere collecten mer, die von der vasten lauten als Inchoata ieiunia und Adesto, Domine, supplicacionibus nostris etc., und der hymnus Ex more docti sollen nicht gehalten werden. Weiter sollen sie underlassen dominica Invocavit: die collect super Bened[ictus] Deus, qui ecclesiam tuam, […] feria secunda nach Reminiscere: die collect super Benedictus Praesta, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, familia tua etc., feria quarta: die collecta super Benedictus Populum tuum, Domine etc., feria quinta: die collect super Benedictus Praesta nobis Domine, quaesumus, feria sexta: super Benedictus collect Da, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus etc., sabbato: super Benedictus collecta Da,quaesumus, Domine nostris effectum; und an diser stat mogen sie allwegen nemen die nachvolgende super populum;

On Ash Wednesday the collect at the Benedictus, *Concede nobis, Domine, praesidia*, and other collects more which speak of the fast, as *Inchoata ieiunia* and *Adesto, Domine, supplicationibus nostris*, etc., and the hymn *Ex more docti*, shall not be kept. Further they shall leave out: on the Sunday Invocavit, the collect at the Benedictus *Deus, qui ecclesiam tuam*; […] on the Monday after Reminiscere, the collect at the Benedictus *Praesta, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, familia tua*, etc.; on the Wednesday, the collect at the Benedictus *Populum tuum, Domine*, etc.; on the Thursday, the collect at the Benedictus *Praesta nobis, Domine, quaesumus*; on the Friday, at the Benedictus the collect *Da, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus*, etc.; on the Saturday, at the Benedictus the collect *Da, quaesumus, Domine, nostris effectum*; and in this place they may always take the *super populum* that followeth.

**What the rule means.** The list goes on through the weeks of Oculi, Laetare and Judica (Sehling 11, pp. 315–316).

- **What it strikes out.** The Lauds collects of the Lenten weekdays are the collects of the day's Mass. Many of them ask that bodily fasting be made fruitful or meritorious. An example is the Monday after Reminiscere: *Praesta, quaesumus, omnipotens Deus, ut familia tua, quae se affligendo carnem ab alimentis abstinet, sectando iustitiam a culpa ieiunet*. Another is the Wednesday: *Populum tuum, Domine, propitius respice: et quos ab escis carnalibus praecipis abstinere, a noxiis quoque vitiis cessare concede*.
- **What it puts in their place.** "The *super populum* that followeth" is the prayer over the people of the same day, which stands after the postcommunion in the Missal. These prayers ask for God's protection, mercy and guidance of his people, without reference to the fast. For the same Monday it is *Adesto supplicationibus nostris, omnipotens Deus: et quibus fiduciam sperandae pietatis indulges, consuetae misericordiae tribue benignus effectum*.

The identification of these texts is this chapter's. Sehling's editor gives no note on the passage.

**The result.** The Lenten prayer over the people outlived the Lenten collect in this one Lutheran order. It did so not at the end of the Mass but at Lauds, and for a doctrinal reason: of the day's two proper prayers it was the one that said nothing of fasting as a work. Ansbach's handling matches Luther's test for the collect in 1523, "if only it be godly" (§5.3.2). The corpus shows no other Lutheran use of the *super populum*.

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## 5.7 Kept, stripped, added, altered

**Table 1. The prayers, compared with the medieval system**

| | Collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Prayer over the people (Lent) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Medieval use** | Proper to the day; sung after the Gloria; multiplied | Proper to the day; said silently over the | Proper to the day; sung after the communion; multiplied with the collects | Proper to the Lenten weekdays; after the postcommunion, with |

| | Collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Prayer over the people (Lent) |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | by commemorations and votive collects | gifts; multiplied with the collects | | the bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*; also used as an office collect |
| **Kept** | The collect of the season or feast (§5.4.2), mostly German versions of the Missal collects; the salutation, *Oremus*, long conclusion and Amen (§5.4.5); the seasonal versicle (Henneberg 1582, Hof 1592) | Only the closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe, Calenberg-Göttingen), and the name in Dortmund 1554 (§5.5.2) | A collect after the communion, with salutation and Amen; often still called the *complenda* (§5.6.3). Proper postcommunions kept in Nürnberg and Volprecht 1524, Coburg 1524, Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation), Erfurt 1525 and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§5.6.2) | Only in the office: Ansbach 1533 allows the day's *super populum* at Lauds (§5.6.6) |
| **Stripped** | Collects of the saints and those asking their intercession (Hannover 1536); the automatic commemorations (Luther: "that one alone") | The prayer itself, everywhere (Prussia 1525: "of necessity left out"); no German secret exists | The proper postcommunion (Luther 1523: "they almost all sound of sacrifice"); gone from the printed orders after 1542 | At the Mass, everywhere; neither the prayer nor the bidding occurs |
| **Added** | Veit Dietrich's gospel collects (Wolfenbüttel 1569, Soest 1609, Buxtehude 1565); new "common" collects for need; the collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* | Open prayers for the magistrates and Christendom in its place (Dortmund 1554); collects for rulers under the Sanctus (Döber 1525, Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543) | Luther's fixed thanksgiving (1526); the Nürnberg thanksgiving (1533); Döber's prayer (1525); Prussia's second collect (1544); a collect or thanksgiving for the Word when there is no communion (Lippe 1571) | — |
| **Altered** | Latin to German "that the people may say Amen" (Coburg 1554/55); one collect as the norm, a second only "for need" (Mecklenburg 1545) or by rule for temporal goods (Ansbach 1548); the Advent *Excita* reworded ("weck uns auf, dass wir bereit sein") | — | Proper to ordinary; Luther's 1523 ablution prayers made public, then expanded (Nürnberg 1533); the Missal postcommunion *Gratias tibi referimus* recast as Luther's thanksgiving; the Corpus Christi collect turned into a postcommunion; two thanksgivings joined "under one conclusion" (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543) | Moved from the end of the Mass to Lauds, in place of collects that "speak of the fast" (Ansbach 1533) |

**Table 2. Did the medieval "two collects, two secrets, two postcommunions" survive?**

| Feature | Survives? | Where |
|---|---|---|
| More than one collect before the epistle | **Yes, in some orders** | Ansbach 1548 (two, by rule); Mecklenburg 1545 (a second "for need"); Wolfstein 1574 and Henneberg ("one or more") |

| Feature | Survives? | Where |
|---|---|---|
| A matching second secret | **No** | The secret is gone altogether |
| A matching second postcommunion | **No, but two postcommunions do occur**, not tied to the collects | Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (Nürnberg and Luther thanksgivings "under one conclusion"); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (Luther's thanksgiving plus the proper postcommunion of the feast) |
| A votive prayer at the end | **Yes** | The collect for peace after *Verleih uns Frieden* (twelve or more orders); Hof 1592's collect "for rain and fair weather" |
| Rules for the conclusions | **Yes** | Hof 1592 (§5.4.5) |
| The Lenten prayer over the people | **Not at the Mass**; once in the office | Ansbach 1533, at Lauds (§5.6.6) |

## 5.8 Table by order

**Key.**

- **L**: Latin. **G**: German or Low German.
- **Proper**: varies with the day. **Fixed**: the same every time.
- **—**: absent or abolished. **?**: not stated.
- "Luther": Luther's thanksgiving of 1526. "Nürnberg": the Brandenburg-Nürnberg thanksgiving of 1533. "Corpus Christi": the German Corpus Christi collect.

| Order | Vol. | Collect | Second collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Alternatives |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1 | L, proper, "one alone" | — | — | L, fixed: *Quod ore*, *Corpus tuum* | either of the two |
| Volprecht, Nürnberg, 1524 | 11 | L "one only"; G proper (Trinity) | — | — | L proper (*de quo sit missa*); G *Proficiat* (Trinity) | — |
| Nürnberg parish Mass, 1524 | 11 | L proper (*Sancti tui nominis*) | — | — (with the offertory) | L proper (*complenda*) | — |
| Coburg proposal, 1524 | 1 | ? | ? | — (with the offertory) | "the complenda" | — |
| Müntzer, Allstedt, 1524 (Radical Reformation) | 1 | G proper (Missal) | — | *Per omnia* only | G proper (Missal postcommunions) | — |
| Strasbourg, Schwarz, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | G | ? | — | G *Quod ore* as *Complenda* | "any other that seemeth Christian" |
| Döber, Nürnberg, 1525 | 11 | ? | Optional "common prayer" before the Sanctus | — | G, new (Döber's) | — |

| Order | Vol. | Collect | Second collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Alternatives |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525 | 2 | G proper | — | ? | G proper (Pentecost, *Proficiat*) | — |
| Prussia, *Artikel*, 1525 | 4 | Proper series by the year | ? | — ("of necessity left out") | Two common complendas, alternating | — |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | G, one, facing the altar | — | — | G fixed (Luther) | — |
| Ansbach, *Ordnung … bei den Stiften*, 1533 | 11 | (office) Lenten Lauds collects "of the fast" struck out | — | — | — | the day's *super populum* at Lauds in their place |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533 | 11 | ? | ? | ? | G fixed (Nürnberg) | — |
| Hatzkerode, 1534(?) | 2 | ? | ? | ? | Luther, called "the complenda" | "or the like" |
| Bremen, 1534 | 7/2.2 | L from the Missal or G from the hymnbook | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Hannover, 1536 | 6/2 | Purged (saints' collects removed) | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Württemberg, 1536 | 16 | Collect series | ? | ? | ? | Corpus Christi as *Oratio de Eucharistia* |
| Saxony (Duke Henry), 1539 | 1 | L or G, "common or of the feasts" | Peace collect | ? | ? | — |
| Brandenburg, 1540 | 3 | ? | Four G collects under the Sanctus | — | G: Nürnberg + Luther under one conclusion; then L *Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore* | — |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542 | 6/2 | G proper (Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Missal) | Collect for rulers under the Sanctus; peace collect at the end | *Per omnia* as "Gott sey preis …" | G: Luther (Nürnberg + Luther in the common Mass) then G proper (Missal) | *Qui dixisti* in the common Mass |
| Schleswig-Holstein, 1542 | 23 | ? | ? | ? | "a collect of thanksgiving" | — |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543 | 13 | ? | Three collects under the Sanctus | Osiander's prayer over the gifts (new) | G: Nürnberg + Luther (to Christ) under one conclusion; then L *Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore* | — |

| Order | Vol. | Collect | Second collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Alternatives |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 4 | ? | ? | ? | Luther | second collect on alternate Sundays |
| Mecklenburg, 1545 | 5 | G "one at a time" | A second "for great need" | ? | Luther | Döber's; Corpus Christi |
| Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 | 11 | Two by rule: spiritual, then temporal | (the second) | ? | ? | — |
| Amberg, 1550 | 13 | L of the season "if it be pure" | ? | ? | Postcommunion "probably that of Pfalz-Neuburg" (editor) | — |
| Breslau, 1550 | 3 | ? | ? | ? | "the complenda" | — |
| Reuss, 1552 | 2 | ? | ? | ? | "the complenda after our church's use", toward the people | — |
| Dortmund, 1554 | 21 | ? | ? | Open prayer for rulers "in place of the Secret" | ? | — |
| Coburg, 1554/55 | 1 | G only, "that the people may sing Amen" | ? | ? | ? | — |
| Senftenberg, 1555 | 1 | ? | ? | ? | "the complenda", in Wendish for the Wends | — |
| Lüneburg, 1564 | 6/1 | G of the season or feast "or that agreeth with the matter" | ? | ? | Luther | ? |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 | 7/1 | Two: Missal (before the sermon), Dietrich (after) | ? | ? | Corpus Christi first | Luther |
| Wolfenbüttel, 1569 | 6/1 | G series; may be Dietrich's gospel collects | ? | ? | Luther | ? |
| Lippe, 1571 | 21 | ? | ? | ? | Luther | without communion: a collect or thanksgiving for the Word |
| Oldenburg, 1573 | 7/2.1 | Very large G series | Peace collect | ? | Luther | Corpus Christi; Nürnberg |

| Order | Vol. | Collect | Second collect | Secret | Postcommunion | Alternatives |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | (Wolfenbüttel's and more) | | | | |
| Wolfstein, 1574 | 13 | G, "one or more" | (as needed) | ? | ? | — |
| Nördlingen, 1579 | 12 | ? | ? | ? | Luther, after a versicle from 1 Cor 11:26 | Corpus Christi, after 1 Cor 11:27 |
| Saxony (Duke August), 1580; Mansfeld, 1580 | 1; 2 | G series | Peace collect (Mansfeld) | ? | Luther | Corpus Christi |
| Grubenhagen, 1581 | 6/2 | G series (Missal) | Peace collect | ? | Luther | Corpus Christi (also on Maundy Thursday) |
| Henneberg, 1582 | 2 | G "pure collects" by season, with versicles | Common collects "for every need" | ? | ? | — |
| Engerhafe, 1583 | 7/1 | ? | ? | ? | Trinitarian thanksgiving in place of Luther's | — |
| Hof, 1592 | 11 | Of the season or "directed to the Lord's Supper"; L at Vespers | "For rain and fair weather" (Vespers) | ? | A collect, e.g. the thanksgiving for the Supper received | — |
| Verden, 1606 | 7/1 | G series | ? | ? | Luther | ? |
| Soest, 1609 | 22 | "That agreeth with the gospel", or one for the Spirit | ? | ? | ? | without communion: a collect of free choice |
| Schaumburg, 1614 | 7/2.2 | G series | Peace collect | ? | ? | ? |
| Osnabrück, (1588) 1618 | 7/1 | G series (Missal, Coelius) | ? | ? | Luther | ? |

## 5.9 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited ("A" = Appendix 5.A).

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523 | 1, pp. 3–6 | 2 | 5.3.2, 5.4.1, 5.4.3, 5.6.1, 5.A |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch messe*, 1524 (Radical Reformation) | 1, pp. 500–504 | 51, 52 | 5.5.2, 5.6.2, 5.A |
| Coburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung* (proposal), 1524 | 1, p. 542 | 72 | 5.6.2 |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation) | 1, p. 506 | 52 | 5.6.6 |
| Erfurt, *Deutsches Kirchenamt*, 1525 | 2, pp. 376–378 | 1251 | 5.6.2, 5.A |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, pp. 14, 16 | 3 | 5.3.3, 5.4.5, 5.A |
| Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?) | 2, p. 587 | 1263 | 5.6.3 |
| Gnandstein, visitation articles, 1539 | 1, p. 564 | 85 | 5.6.6 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539 | 1, pp. 274–278 | 30 | 5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.5 |
| Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552 | 2, p. 154 | 1234 | 5.6.3 |
| Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation of 1554/55 | 1, p. 544 | 74 | 5.4.5 |
| Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1555 | 1, p. 672 | 136 | 5.6.3 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 369, 375 | 44 | 5.4.2, 5.6.3, 5.6.4, 5.6.5 |
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 | 2, pp. 227–231 | 1241 | 5.4.2, 5.6.4 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582 | 2, pp. 317, 320 | 1247 | 5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.3 |
| Henneberg, a pastor's report | 2, p. 330 | 1248 | 5.4.1 |

**Franconia, the Upper Palatinate and Swabia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht*, 1524 | 11, pp. 39, 42 | 247 | 5.4.1, 5.5.1, 5.6.2, 5.A |
| Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524 | 11, pp. 46–49 | 249 | 5.3.1, 5.4.1, 5.5.1, 5.6.2 |
| Nürnberg, *Deutsche Messe des A. Döber*, 1525 | 11, pp. 54–55 | 250 | 5.5.2, 5.6.4, 5.A |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533 | 11, pp. 315–316 | 276 | 5.6.6 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, p. 197 | 270 | 5.6.4, 5.A |
| Württemberg, *Gemein kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16, p. 125 | 651 | 5.6.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, p. 76 | 386 | 5.5.2, 5.6.1, 5.6.4 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order) | 11, p. 330 | 278 | 5.4.1 |
| Amberg (Kuroberpfalz), *Kirchenordnung*, 1550 | 13, p. 286 | 411 | 5.4.3, 5.4.5 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574 | 13, p. 576 | 463 | 5.4.1, 5.4.5 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579 | 12, p. 382 | 375 | 5.6.3, 5.6.4 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 411–429 | 294 | 5.4.1, 5.4.2, 5.4.5 |

**Brandenburg, Prussia, Silesia, Mecklenburg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchenordnung*, 1525 | 4, pp. 32, 37 | 1832, 1833 | 5.5.1, 5.6.4 |
| Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, p. 70 | 1746 | 5.5.2, 5.6.1, 5.6.4 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 4, p. 66 | 1833 | 5.6.4 |
| Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 | 5, pp. 152, 155 | 1922 | 5.4.1, 5.4.5, 5.6.3, 5.6.4 |
| Breslau, 1550 | 3, p. 404 | 1807 | 5.6.3 |

**Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the North**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 459 | 2217 | 5.4.5 |
| Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 6/2, p. 1009 | 2051 | 5.4.3 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, pp. 816–834 | 2036, 2037 | 5.4.1, 5.5.2, 5.6.2, 5.6.4, 5.A |
| Lippe, Corvinus's *Zeremonienordnung*, [1542] | 21, p. 352 | 1460 | 5.4.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Christlyke Kercken Ordeninge*, 1542 | 23, p. 91 | 1576 | 5.6.3 |
| Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554 | 21, p. 209 | 1446 | 5.5.2 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 542–543, 568–573 | 2003, 2005 | 5.3.3, 5.4.2, 5.4.4 |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 (and Sehling's introduction) | 7/1, pp. 67, 92–98, 125 | 2080, 2082 | 5.4.2, 5.4.4, 5.6.4 |
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 178–179 | 1974 | 5.4.2, 5.4.4 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, p. 397 | 1462 | 5.6.5 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 (and Sehling's introduction) | 7/2.1, pp. 962, 1134–1145 | 2142, 2151 | 5.4.2, 5.4.4, 5.6.4 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1076–1081 | 2058 | 5.4.2, 5.6.4 |
| Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583 | 7/1, p. 681 | 2119 | 5.6.4 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 | 10, p. 622 | 228 | 5.4.2 |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, p. 161 | 2090 | 5.3.3, 5.4.2, 5.6.3, 5.A |
| Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1609 | 22, pp. 488, 495 | 1538 | 5.4.4, 5.6.5 |
| Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614 | 7/2.2, p. 150 | 2178 | 5.4.1, 5.4.2 |
| Osnabrück, *Agende*, (1588) 1618 | 7/1, pp. 270–278 | 2100 | 5.4.2, 5.6.3 |

**Strasbourg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, the early agendas: Schwarz's German Mass and the *Teutsche Meß*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, pp. 123, 133, 135 | 1279 | 5.3.1, 5.6.1, 5.A |

## Appendix 5.A The postcommunion texts and their sources

The prayers used after the communion in the corpus, with their Latin sources where one exists. "Ed." means that Sehling's editors make the identification; "this chapter" means that the identification is this chapter's own. The texts and translations are given in the sections named.

| German incipit | Latin source | Identified by | Orders | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| (Latin) *Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus* | Priest's prayer at the ablutions, Ordo Missae | Luther 1523 | Luther 1523; Brandenburg 1540; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 | 5.3.2, 5.6.1 |
| (Latin) *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsimus* … | Priest's prayer at the ablutions, Ordo Missae | Luther 1523 | Luther 1523; Brandenburg 1540; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 | 5.3.2, 5.6.1 |
| "Das wir mit mund haben zu uns genomen, verlyhe uns, herr …" | *Quod ore sumpsimus* | Evident from the text | Strasbourg 1524 (*Complenda*; Moderate Reformed); Volprecht 1524 | 5.6.1 |
| "Die empfahung deines sacraments, o Herr, unser Gott …" / "O herre got, lass uns zu nutz kummen … die entphahunge des heiligen sacraments" | *Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae* (Trinity Sunday, postcommunion) | Chapter 7 (Volprecht); this chapter (Erfurt) | Volprecht 1524 (Trinity); Erfurt 1525 (Trinity) | 5.6.2 |
| "O herr geuss in uns den geist der liebe …" / "Herr, uberschütte uns mit deinem Geiste …" | *Spiritum nobis, Domine, tuae caritatis infunde* (Easter, postcommunion) | Ed. (Calenberg-Göttingen); this chapter (Müntzer) | Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 | 5.6.2 |
| "O herr vorlei uns die gnad des heiligen geists, auf das der thau deiner güte …" | *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio* (Pentecost, postcommunion) | Ed. (Calenberg-Göttingen); Chapter 7 | Müntzer 1524 (Radical Reformation); Erfurt 1525; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 | 5.6.2 |
| "Herre, las uns entpfangen an mittel des tempels deine barmherzigkeit …" | *Suscipiamus, Domine, misericordiam tuam in medio templi tui* (1st Sunday in Advent, postcommunion) | Ed. | Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 | 5.6.2 |
| "O herr gott, steh hart bei uns …" | none known (new) | Chapter 7 | Müntzer 1524 (Advent; Radical Reformation) | 5.6.2 |
| "Wir danken dir, allmechtiger Herr Gott, das du uns durch diese heilsame gabe hast erquicket …" | *Gratias tibi referimus, Domine, sacro munere vegetati* (18th Sunday after Pentecost, postcommunion) | Ed. (Verden, after Drews) | Luther 1526, and nearly every later order | 5.3.3, 5.6.3 |
| "O almechtiger, ewiger Got. Wir sagen deiner götlichen miltigkeit lob und dank …" | none (new); expands *Quod ore sumpsimus* | This chapter | Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533; Brandenburg 1540; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542; | 5.6.4 |

| German incipit | Latin source | Identified by | Orders | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Oldenburg 1573 | |
| "O Herr, allmechtiger Got, verleih uns … das wir durch den zeitlichen tod deines Suns …" | "apparently newly made" (ed.); perhaps from *Fac nos … quam pretiosi Corporis et Sanguinis tui temporalis perceptio praefigurat* (Corpus Christi, postcommunion) | Ed.; suggestion of this chapter | Döber 1525; Mecklenburg 1545 | 5.6.4 |
| "Ach du lieber Herre Gott, der du uns bei diesem wunderbarlichen sacrament deines leidens zu gedenken und predigen befohlen hast …" | *Deus, qui nobis sub sacramento mirabili passionis tuae memoriam reliquisti* (Corpus Christi, collect) | This chapter; ed. trace it to the Wittenberg hymnbook of 1533 | Württemberg 1536; Mecklenburg 1545; Buxtehude 1565; Oldenburg 1573; Nördlingen 1579; Saxony 1580; Mansfeld 1580; Grubenhagen 1581 | 5.6.4 |
| "O warhaftiger got, barmherziger vater … las uns dürftigen des heiligen leidens unsers herren nutz und frucht … ergreifen" | none known | — | Prussia 1544 (alternate Sundays) | 5.6.4 |
| "O Herr Jhesu Christe, der du deinen apostelen gesagt hast: Meinen friden geb ich euch …" | *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti apostolis tuis* (Ordo Missae, prayer for peace) | Ed. | Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (common Mass) | 5.6.2 |
| "Herr Gott, himlischer Vater, der du heiligen muth, guten rath und rechte werke schaffest …" (after *Verleih uns Frieden*) | *Deus, a quo sancta desideria, recta consilia, et iusta sunt opera* (Mass for peace) | Ed. | Saxony 1539; Calenberg-Göttingen 1542; Henneberg 1582; Grubenhagen 1581; Oldenburg 1573; Schaumburg 1614; and others | 5.4.1, 5.6.2 |

# Chapter 6. The General Prayer of the Church: Texts by Family

The general prayer (*das gemein Gebet*, the Prayer of the Church) is the intercession for all estates and needs in the chief Sunday service of the church orders in the Sehling corpus. This chapter does two things:

- §§6.1–6.3 say what the general prayer is, where it stands in the service, and how its texts are related.
- §§6.4–6.21 give the texts themselves, one family at a time. For each petition the original is followed by the English, for the rubric, the bid and the prayer in turn. Each family can be read straight through, in the order in which the prayer runs.

The texts are the **representative texts** of the general-prayer workbook, `general_prayers.xlsx` (Introduction). They come from four sheets of the workbook:

- **Orig Prayers - Representative**;
- **Eng Prayers - Representative**;
- **Orig Bids - Representative**;
- **Eng Bids - Representative**.

The workbook sets these out with one row per category and one column per family, so that one intention can be compared across the families. Here they are turned around: each family's column is printed as a single prayer.

The Introduction (The general-prayer workbook and database) describes the workbook and `general_prayers.db`: how the texts were curated and checked against the corpus, the categories, and how the critical and representative texts are made. The workbook also gives:

- every witness's own text, in the **Prayers** sheet;
- the variants within a family, in the **Archetypes** sheet and the critical sheets;
- the orders side by side, petition by petition, in the **Compare** sheet.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere:

- the place of the general prayer in the order of the Mass: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- the prayer before the sermon, the greeting and the notices: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- the Litany and the bidding prayers: Chapter 13, §13.22;
- the intercessions under the Sanctus in the Masses that have them: Chapter 7, §§7.8.11, 7.12.2, 7.14.4;
- the collects: Chapter 5, §5.4.

The labels of the texts (rubric, bid, prayer and witnesses) are explained in the Conventions.

## 6.1 The general prayer in the Sunday service

### 6.1.1 What it is

Every order in this set (57 witnesses, dated 1526–1618) has one prayer in the chief service of the Sunday in which the congregation prays for the Church and her ministers, the magistrates, the afflicted and the other needs of Christendom. The orders call it:

- *das gemein gebet*, the common prayer. This is the usual name: Württemberg 1553 has "Ordnung des gemeinen gebets", Leipzig 1567 "Gemein gebet".
- *Vermanung zum gebet*, the exhortation to prayer: Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Strasbourg 1598. Nürnberg 1545 has "Vermanung zu bitten für allerlei stende".
- *Fürbitt* or *Vorbitt*, intercession: Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling's heading), Öhringen 1544.
- *Exhortatio edder vormaninge*, exhortation or admonition: Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529.
- *Oratio*: the Latin order of the French church at Frankfurt, 1554 (Reformed).

Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed) gives it as the fifth part of the service and grounds it in the practice of the first Church:

> Von solchem gebet, so uf die auslegung der schrift und predigt gefolget hat in der ersten kirchen, redet sehr kurz Iustinus in der andern Apologia, da er spricht: Post exhortationes ab eo qui praeest factas, surgimus omnes ac

> comprecamur, das ist, wenn die predigt vom öbersten lehrer volendet, stehen wir alle uf und beten. (Sehling 8, p. 245)

> Of such prayer, which in the first Church followed upon the exposition of the Scripture and the sermon, Justin speaketh very briefly in his second Apology, where he saith: *After the exhortations made by him that presideth, we all rise and pray together*; that is, when the sermon of the chief teacher is ended, we all stand up and pray.

What counts as the general prayer, and what is left out (collect banks, the Litany, prayer-day and afternoon forms), is set out in the Introduction (What counts as the general prayer).

#### 6.1.2 Where it stands in the service

**After the sermon.** In 48 of the 57 witnesses the prayer follows the sermon, and in most of them it is said from the pulpit. Kursachsen 1580 has it said "allezeit nach der predigt … dem volk auf der canzel" (always after the sermon … to the people from the pulpit). In these orders the prayer is the hinge between the service of the Word and the Supper, and it is often joined to the items around it:

- **Before it, in many orders:** an open confession and absolution, or the publishing of banns and notices. Examples:
  - confession and absolution in Neckarbischofsheim 1560, Erbach 1560, Hohenlohe 1578, the Ysenburg orders, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569, Oldenburg 1573 and Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed);
  - banns and notices in Hohenlohe 1578, Solms-Laubach 1576, Strasbourg 1598 and Frankfurt 1554 (Reformed).
- **After it:** the Our Father, which closes almost every form. Then:
  - a psalm or hymn, such as "Erhalt uns Herr", "Verleih uns Frieden" or "Danck sagen wir alle";
  - a collect and the blessing when there is no Communion;
  - otherwise the Supper. In Lüneburg 1564 and its followers the communicants come into the choir and kneel.

**Elsewhere in the service.** The other nine witnesses place it as follows:

| Place | Witnesses |
|---|---|
| In the Mass, said by the priest in German under the Sanctus, before or after the Words of Institution | Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (family L) |
| In the Communion office, after the exhortation to the communicants, before the Words of Institution | Frankfurt 1553 and 1589 |
| After the Kyrie and Gloria, in place of the Latin collect, read from a lectern before the altar (the sermon precedes the whole service) | Schwäbisch Hall 1526 |
| In place of the Epistle in the village Mass, followed by the Creed, the Ten Commandments and the catechism (the medieval pulpit office) | Nürnberg 1545 |
| After the Gospel has been expounded from the pulpit and the catechism recited, before the Creed and Preface | Osnabrück 1543 |
| From the pulpit, when the choir has finished the first psalm or hymn | Worms 1560 |

The Brandenburg prayers keep the place of the old intercessions of the Canon. Sehling notes on Pfalz-Neuburg 1543:

> Diese Gebete sind an die Stelle der in der römischen Messe teils vor teils nach der Konsekration gesprochenen Fürbittgebete gesetzt. Sie wurden sonst in evangelischen Kirchenordnungen ohne Ersatz gestrichen, weil sie den von der Reformation abgelehnten Opfercharakter der Messe zur Grundlage haben. (Sehling 13, p. 74)

> These prayers are set in the place of the intercessory prayers spoken in the Roman Mass partly before and partly after the consecration. Elsewhere in the evangelical church orders these were struck out without replacement, because they rest upon the sacrificial character of the Mass, which the Reformation rejected.

**Who says it.** The minister says it: the pastor or the deacon from the pulpit, or the priest at the altar in family L. In Schwäbisch Hall 1526 it is read from a lectern before the altar, in a cope. The people take part:

- by saying the Our Father;

- by the confession, which they say after the minister in Braunschweig ("spreket ock de bicht mit my") and in Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 ("Bekennet mit mir vor Gott ewer sunde");
- by praying "mit mund und herzen" (with mouth and heart), as the Leipzig print of 1567 directs.

#### 6.1.3 Its forms

The witnesses use six forms. Each family keeps to one form, except for the two prescriptions of contents: Magdeburg 1562 (in B2) and Osnabrück 1543 (in H).

| Form | How it runs | Families | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bidding and collect | For each intention the minister bids the people ("Lasst uns bitten für …"), then says a collect | A, B1 | 10 |
| Bidding exhortation | The minister tells the people what to pray for, item by item, without addressing God, and closes with the Our Father | C, D, G, H, I, J, M | 14 |
| Continuous prayer | One prayer to God that names the intentions in turn ("Wöllest auch …") | B2, E, F, R1, R3, R4 | 25 |
| Collects | Separate collects without biddings: three from the pulpit (K), or the priest's collects under the Sanctus (L) | K, L | 4 |
| Lord's Prayer paraphrase | The intentions are arranged under the petitions of the Our Father | R2 (and the close of R3) | 2 |
| Prescription of contents | Not a text to be read, but a list in indirect speech of what the prayer must contain | Magdeburg 1562 (B2), Osnabrück 1543 (H) | 2 |

**Long and short forms.** Württemberg 1553 prints a long form (B1) and a short form (B2). Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 says when each is to be used:

> Dises gebet, dieweil es zimlich lang ist, mögen die Kirchendiener etwan an den grossen Festen gebrauchen, als am Christag, Ostern und Pfingsten, und sonst jeder zeit im jar, wann die Kirch one das mit der predig nit lang auffgehalten wirt, sonst sollen sie die kürtzere form, welche hernach folget, gemeinigklich dem Volck fürlesen. (Sehling 18, p. 195)

> This prayer, forasmuch as it is somewhat long, the ministers of the Church may use at the great feasts, as on Christmas Day, Easter and Pentecost, and at any other time in the year when the church is not otherwise held long by the sermon; else they shall commonly read to the people the shorter form, which followeth hereafter.

The short form became the most copied prayer in the corpus (17 witnesses, 1553–1618).

**Alternatives and freedom.** Some orders allow the prayer to vary:

- **The Litany instead.** The Litany is the second form of the common prayer in Württemberg 1553 and Rothenburg 1559. It is prayed on Fridays in the towns of Kursachsen 1580 and on alternate Sundays in Rothenberg 1618.
- **A choice of texts.** Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed) offers a Lord's-Prayer paraphrase, "Oder also" (or thus), beside its Sunday prayer (R2). Augsburg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) offers two texts against the Turk.
- **Local adaptation.**
  - Hessen 1566 (Moderate Reformed) lets each church make the form "kürzer oder lenger" (shorter or longer).
  - Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573 tells the pastor to refer to the sermon and to present needs.
  - Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (Reformed) lets ministers add to the prayer in time of need.
  - Many forms end with a rubric that lets the sick and other particular needs be named (the category *Special intercessions*).

#### 6.1.4 The sequence of intentions

**Lutheran.** The usual Lutheran series goes back to Brenz 1526 and Württemberg 1553:

exhortation > Church > magistrates > afflicted > peace > enemies > women with child > fruits of the earth > Our Father.

**Reformed.** The Heidelberg prayer of 1563 begins with confession and thanksgiving, prays for the fruit of the Word, and has a petition for all men (1 Tim 2:1):

confession > thanksgiving > Word > magistrates > fruits of the earth > all men > persecuted > afflicted > Our Father.

**What all share.** Civil authority is the one intention found in every witness. The Introduction (What the comparison shows) sets out the other patterns.

**Traditions.**

The traditions follow the inventory in Chapter 1, §1.3. Every order of another tradition than the Lutheran is marked where it is cited, by its tradition in brackets after it, as "Kurpfalz 1563 (Reformed)".

- Eleven families are Lutheran: A to E and H to L.
- F (Augsburg 1537) is Moderate Reformed: Upper German and Bucerian.
- G (Hessen 1566) is Moderate Reformed: the church of Philip of Hesse, between Wittenberg and the Upper Germans, which bore Bucer's stamp.
- M (Norden 1528) is an early East Frisian evangelical order, which Sehling prints among the Reformed orders of East Frisia; it is marked Reformed here.
- R1–R4 are Reformed. Schaumburg 1614, a Lutheran order, takes over the Heidelberg prayer of R1.
- No Interim order is among the witnesses.

## 6.2 How the texts are given here

**Representative texts.** A family's representative text is one clean text for each category, made from all the family's witnesses by majority:

- a petition, bid or prayer is kept if at least half the witnesses to that category have it;
- word by word, the reading of the majority is chosen;
- where no reading has half the witnesses, the earliest witness's reading stands.

Every word comes from a witness, but in a family with several witnesses the result need not match any one witness exactly. Where a family has a single witness, its text is that witness's text. The rules are given in full in the Introduction (Representative texts).

**Order.** The workbook lists the categories in a standard order. Here each family's petitions follow the order in which its prayer actually runs:

- the order of the family's earliest witness;
- with petitions that only later witnesses have placed where those witnesses have them.

Where a family has more than one petition in a category (two petitions for the magistrates in Lüneburg 1564, or the confession and the absolution), the workbook cell holds them both, separated by a blank line. Here each is given in its own place.

**Exact reproduction.** The petitions of each family, joined category by category, reproduce the four workbook sheets exactly. This was checked for all 2,016 cells (28 categories × 18 families × 4 sheets), with no differences. The workbook's "Bids" sheets put the rubric on the first line of the bid; here the rubric and the bid are given separately.

**Each petition** is numbered within its family (A.1, A.2, …) and headed with its category. For families with more than one witness, a line in italics names the witnesses that have the petition. It also notes where a rubric, bid or prayer is in only some of them. Then come, in turn:

- the rubric, original then English;
- the bid, original then English;
- the prayer, original then English.

Each part is given only where the petition has it.

**Not taken in.** Each family section lists the witness petitions that are not in the representative text, because another reading of the same category has the majority. Those texts are in the **Prayers** sheet and in the critical sheets.

### 6.3 The families at a glance

One row per family, in the order of the workbook columns. "Petitions" is the number of petitions in the representative text given below.

| Family | Name | Tradition | Language | Form | Witnesses | Dates | Petitions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A | Brenz bidding prayer | Lutheran | German | bidding + collect | 5 | 1526–1589 | 15 |
| B1 | Württemberg long form | Lutheran | German | preface, then bidding + collect for each intention | 5 | 1553–1574 | 13 |
| B2 | Württemberg short form | Lutheran | German | exhortation + one continuous prayer | 17 | 1553–1618 | 15 |
| C | Bidding exhortation (Strasbourg type) | Lutheran | German | bidding exhortation + Our Father | 1 | 1573 | 8 |
| D | Nürnberg-type Vermahnung zum Gebet | Lutheran | German | bidding exhortation + Our Father | 5 | 1545–1582 | 15 |
| E | Saxon Gemein Gebet (Melanchthon/Pfeffinger) | Lutheran | German | continuous prayer | 1 | 1567 | 6 |
| F | Upper German pulpit intercession (Strasbourg/Zürich) | Moderate Reformed (Upper German, Bucerian) | German | continuous prayer with rubrics + Our Father | 1 | 1537 | 16 |
| G | Hessian Vermanung zum Gebet | Moderate Reformed (Hessian, Bucerian) | German | numbered bidding exhortation | 1 | 1566 | 9 |
| H | Bugenhagen pulpit exhortation | Lutheran | Low German | pulpit exhortation: Creed, confession, biddings, Our Father | 3 | 1528–1543 | 9 |
| I | Huberinus Vorbitt (Lord's-Prayer order) | Lutheran | German | bidding exhortation + Our Father | 1 | 1544 | 9 |
| J | Lower Saxon notel (Lüneburg/Wolfenbüttel) | Lutheran | German | bidding exhortation + Our Father | 3 | 1564–1573 | 8 |

| Family | Name | Tradition | Language | Form | Witnesses | Dates | Petitions |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| K | Three collects from the pulpit | Lutheran | German | exhortation + three collects | 1 | 1560 | 5 |
| L | Intercessions under the Sanctus (Brandenburg 1540) | Lutheran | German | collects said by the priest under the Sanctus | 3 | 1540–1543 | 5 |
| M | Pulpit biddings in the Prone pattern | Reformed (early East Frisian evangelical order) | Low Dutch | biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed, Our Father | 1 | 1528 | 4 |
| R1 | Heidelberg 1563 prayer | Reformed (Schaumburg 1614 Lutheran) | German | confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Our Father | 5 | 1563–1614 | 10 |
| R2 | Heidelberg Lord’s-Prayer paraphrase | Reformed | German | Lord's Prayer paraphrase | 2 | 1563–1588 | 9 |
| R3 | Calvin’s “grande prière” (Strasbourg/Geneva) | Reformed | Latin | continuous prayer ending in a Lord's Prayer paraphrase | 1 | 1554 | 10 |
| R4 | à Lasco/Micron (London stranger church) | Reformed | German | continuous prayer + Our Father | 1 | 1554 | 10 |

### 6.4 Family A: Brenz bidding prayer

Deacon or pastor bids the people for one intention ("Lasst uns bitten für …"), then says a collect for it; the series runs Church, magistrates, peace, afflicted, all needs, and closes with the Lord's Prayer. Frankfurt adds collects from Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 and Veit Dietrich.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Schwäbisch Hall 1526 (Brenz).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding + collect.
- **Place in the service (Schwäbisch Hall 1526):** After the Kyrie and Gloria, in place of the Latin Oremus/collect; read from a lectern before the altar in a cope. The sermon precedes the whole service.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1526 | Schwäbisch Hall, Frühmessordnung (Johannes Brenz) | Schwäbisch Hall (Imperial city) | Sehling 17, I/1, pp. 37–40 | bidding + collect |
| 1543 | Schwäbisch Hall, Kirchenordnung 1543 | Schwäbisch Hall (Imperial city) | Sehling 17, I/10, pp. 142–145 | bidding + collect |
| 1553 | Frankfurt am Main, Agende 1553 („Einfeltige form, das Nachtmal des Herren zuhalten“) | Frankfurt am Main (Imperial city) | Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 10, pp. 524–526 | bidding + collect |

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1560 | Neckarbischofsheim, Kirchenordnung (Herren von Helmstatt) | Lordship of Neckarbischofsheim (Kraichgau) | Sehling 16, V, pp. 670–672 | bidding + collect |
| 1589 | Frankfurt am Main, Agende 1589 | Frankfurt am Main (Imperial city) | Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 13, pp. 552–553 | bidding + collect |

The representative text follows Brenz's Schwäbisch Hall form of 1526, which the later witnesses copy with small changes. Where they part from it, as in the preface and the close, its reading stands. Following the family's own majority, each bid ends "Bittend also:" and the collects end bare (see the Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

A.9 to A.13 (the Our Father, Creed and Decalogue printed as part of the prayer, and the closing rubric) stand in Schwäbisch Hall 1526 (A.9 also in 1543). A.14 is Frankfurt 1589's own closing prayer for the communicants and A.15 Neckarbischofsheim 1560's closing word of assurance. They come at the end, after the Our Father, as in those orders.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Frankfurt 1553 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Frankfurt 1553 no. 7 (Lord's Prayer); Neckarbischofsheim 1560 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Neckarbischofsheim 1560 no. 9 (Lord's Prayer); Frankfurt 1589 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Frankfurt 1589 no. 7 (Lord's Prayer).

**Sequence:** A.1 Exhortation / preface > A.2 The Church > A.3 Civil authority > A.4 The afflicted > A.5 Peace > A.6 Enemies > A.7 Women with child > A.8 Fruits of the earth > A.9 Lord's Prayer > A.10 Lord's Prayer > A.11 Creed > A.12 Ten Commandments > A.13 Special intercessions > A.14 Communicants > A.15 Blessing.

#### A.1 Exhortation / preface

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526 and Schwäbisch Hall 1543.

**Rubric (German).** Vorrede

**Rubric (English).** Preface

**Bid (German).** Auff das all glaubig zubeten gereitzt wurden, so hat unser Herr Cristus dem gebet ein ernstlich versicherung angehengkt, sprechendt: Bitten, so werden ir gewert, suchendt, so werden ir finden, klopffet an, so wirt euch auffgethon.

**Bid (English).** To the end that all the faithful might be stirred up to pray, our Lord Christ hath annexed unto prayer an earnest assurance, saying: Ask, and ye shall be granted; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

#### A.2 The Church

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

**Bid (German).** Hieruff lassent uns fleyssig bitten fur die gemein cristenlich kirch, fur der kirchen diener, das sie unser Herr Got wolle beschutzen wider all anleuff und versuchung des boßen feinds, darmit sie auff dem starcken felsen, unserm Herrn Cristo, bestendig pleyben. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Hereupon let us diligently pray for the common Christian Church, and for the ministers of the Church, that the Lord our God would defend them against all the assaults and temptation of the wicked enemy, that they may abide steadfast upon the strong rock, our Lord Christ. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger, ewiger Got, der du hast allen volckern dein gnad durch Jesum Cristum und sein Evangelion geoffenbaret, erhalt, Herr, das volck deiner barmhertzikait, das dein kirch sampt iren dienern, inn der gantzen welt zerstrewt, dir mit rechtem glauben diene und in bekantnus deins namens bestande.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, who hast revealed thy grace unto all peoples through Jesus Christ and his Gospel: preserve, O Lord, the people of thy mercy, that thy Church together with her ministers, scattered abroad in the whole world, may serve thee with right faith and continue in the confession of thy name.

**A.3 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten auß gebot und bevelh unsers Herrn Jesu Cristi und seiner Apposteln fur unsern allergnedigsten Herrn, den kaiser, fur alle konig und amptlewt des weltlichen Regiments, sonderlich fur ein erbare Oberkait diser stat, auff das wir ein geruwigs und stils leben in aller gotselikait furen mogen. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray, by the commandment and bidding of our Lord Jesus Christ and of his apostles, for our most gracious Lord the Emperor, for all kings and officers of the temporal government, and especially for an honourable magistracy of this city, that we may lead a quiet and peaceable life in all godliness. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Barmhertziger, Himelischer Vater, in welchs handt bestehet aller menschen gewalt und Oberkait von dir gesetzt zur straff der bösen und wolfart der frummen, in welchs handt auch steen all Recht und gesatz aller Reich, Wir bitten dich, sihe gnedigklich auff unsern Herrn, den kaiser, und all sein amptlewt, nemlich auff ein Oberkait diser Stat, darmit sie das weltlich schwerdt, inen von dir bevolhen, in glauben nach deinem wort und bevelh furen mogen.

**Prayer (English).** Merciful, heavenly Father, in whose hand standeth the power and authority of all men, set of thee for the punishment of the wicked and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all kingdoms: we beseech thee, look graciously upon our Lord the Emperor and all his officers, and namely upon the magistracy of this city, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, in faith, according to thy word and commandment.

**A.4 The afflicted**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten Got, unsern Herrn, das er die welt von Irthum erlosen wol, auch von kranckhaiten, Tewerung, gefengknus, sterben und aller widerwertikait, so durch den bosen feindt uns zur verderpnus zugefugt werden. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray God our Lord, that he would deliver the world from error, and also from sicknesses, dearth, imprisonment, death, and all adversity which by the wicked enemy is brought upon us unto our destruction. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger, ewiger Got, ein trost der trawrigen, ein sterck der schwachen, laß fur dein angesicht komen die bit aller deren, so in bekumernus unnd anfechtung zu dir seufftzen, das menigklich dein hilff und beystand in der zeyt der nodt entpfinde.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, the comfort of the sorrowful, the strength of the weak: let the prayer of all them that sigh unto thee in trouble and temptation come before thy face, through our Lord Jesus Christ, that every man may feel thy help and succour in the time of need.

**A.5 Peace**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten umb ein gemeinen friden und besserung der gantzen Cristenhait, das uns got mit zeitlichem und ewigklichem friden gnedigklich begabe. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for a common peace and for the amendment of all Christendom, that God would graciously endue us with temporal and everlasting peace. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, ewiger Got, ein Herr Himels und der erden, durch welchs gaist alle ding regirt, durch welchs fursehung alle ding geordnet werden, ein Got des Frids, wir bitten dich durch unsern Herrn Jesum Cristum, du wollest unsern sunden vergeben und uns mit dem gaist des frids salben, darmit wir in forcht und zittern dir dienen, zu lob und preys deines namens dienen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, Lord of heaven and earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered, the God of peace: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ, that thou wouldest forgive our sins and anoint us with the spirit of peace, that we may serve thee in fear and trembling, to the laud and praise of thy name.

**A.6 Enemies**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560. *Schwäbisch Hall 1543 lacks the rubric.*

**Rubric (German).** Fur unsere Feind

**Rubric (English).** For our enemies

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten fur unsere feind, das Got sie fur in ir aigne erkantnus und sie von irem unrechten abfur. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for our enemies, that God would lead them into the knowledge of themselves and lead them away from their unrighteousness. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger, ewiger Got, der du uns bevolhen hast, das wir unsere feindt sollen liben, fur unsere verfolger bitten, wir schreyhen hertzlich zu dir, das du wellest unsere feind gnedigklich heimsuchen und inen ein fruntlich, einhellig gemut unnd hertz mit uns und der gantzen Cristenhait geben.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, who hast commanded us to love our enemies and to pray for our persecutors: we cry heartily unto thee, that thou wouldest graciously visit our enemies, and give them a friendly and one-accorded mind and heart with us and with all Christendom.

**A.7 Women with child**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Frankfurt 1553, Neckarbischofsheim 1560 and Frankfurt 1589.

**Bid (German).** Lassent uns auch bitten fur all schwanger frawen, das got sie gnedigklich von kinds banden erlosen wol. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for all women with child, that God would graciously deliver them from the bonds of childbirth. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, ewiger Gott und Vater, ein schöpffer aller ding, der du man und weyp gnediglich gesegnet und dem weyp iren kumer im gebern zu einem hailigen Creutz durch unsern Herrn Jesum Cristum geweyhet hast, wir bitten dich, Herr Got, du wollest die frucht ires leips, dein aigen geschöpff, erhalten und bewaren und unter dem Creutz inn der bekümmerlichen geburt nicht verderben laßen, sonder gnedigklich entpinden.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God and Father, Creator of all things, who hast graciously blessed man and woman, saying: Be fruitful and multiply; and hast made the woman's sorrow in bearing an holy cross through our Lord Jesus Christ: we beseech thee, Lord God, that thou wouldest preserve and keep the fruit of her womb, thine own creature, and suffer her not to perish under the cross of the painful birth, but graciously deliver her.

**A.8 Fruits of the earth**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526, Schwäbisch Hall 1543 and Neckarbischofsheim 1560. *Schwäbisch Hall 1543 lacks the rubric.*

**Rubric (German).** Fur die Fruchten der erden

**Rubric (English).** For the fruits of the earth

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten fur die frucht der erden, das sie Got wol gesegnen und uns wol geraten lassen. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for the fruits of the earth, that God would bless them and let them prosper well for us. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger, barmhertziger, ewiger Got, der du durch dein wort alle ding erschafest und gesegnest, wir bitten dich, das du den somen deins worts unsern Herrn Jesum Cristum, uns wollest mittailn und in unser Hertz pflantzest, dardurch an uns gesegnet werd mit fruchtbarer wachsung und gotlichem gebrauch alles, was uns zur leblichen noturft dienet.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, merciful, everlasting God, who through thy word createst and blessest all things: we beseech thee that thou wouldest impart unto us the seed of thy word, our Lord Jesus Christ, and sow him in our heart, whereby there may be blessed unto us, with fruitful increase and godly use, all that serveth us for our bodily need.

**A.9 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526 and Schwäbisch Hall 1543. *The rubric is in Schwäbisch Hall 1526 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Gemein Gebet

**Rubric (English).** Common prayer

**Bid (German).** Lassendt uns auch bitten sonst fur alles, so Got, unser Herr, gebetten sein wil, sprechend ein Vater unser.

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray besides for all things for which God our Lord will be prayed unto, saying an Our Father.

**A.10 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

**Rubric (German).** Des Herrn Gebet

**Rubric (English).** The Lord’s Prayer

**Prayer (German).** Vater unser in dem himel, etc.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

**A.11 Creed**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

**Rubric (German).** Die bekantnus des Glaubens

**Rubric (English).** The confession of the faith

**Prayer (German).** Ich glaub in Got vater, almechtigen.

**Prayer (English).** I believe in God the Father Almighty.

**A.12 Ten Commandments**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

**Rubric (German).** Die zehen gebot

**Rubric (English).** The Ten Commandments

**Prayer (German).** Disse wort hat der Herr alle geredt: Ich bin der Herr, etc.

**Prayer (English).** The Lord spake all these words: I am the Lord, etc.

**A.13 Special intercessions**

*Witnesses:* Schwäbisch Hall 1526.

**Rubric (German).** Das wer nu fur das gemein gebet. Man mocht alwegen gebet hintzusetzen nach zufallenden sachen mit kriegen, pestilentz oder sonderlichen kranckhaiten, etc.

**Rubric (English).** This, then, were for the common prayer. Prayers might always be added thereto according to matters as they befall, with wars, pestilence, or special sicknesses, etc.

**A.14 Communicants**

*Witnesses:* Frankfurt 1589.

**Prayer (German).** Uber das alles bitten wir, O Herr Jesu Christe, dich, der du dieses Sacraments stiffter und erhalter bist, daß du uns, die wir solches zu entpfahen hie erscheinen, deinen Heiligen Geist laut deiner vielfältigen Verheissung reichlich mittheilen wöllest, der unsere Hertzen stärcke und erhalte in ungezweiffeltem Glauben deiner Wort, in warer Erkanntnuß, Reuw und Leyd unserer Sünde und in festem vertrawen auff dein allein genugthuhung für dieselbigen, damit wir nicht unwirdiglich, sonder wirdiglich der thewren Pfande deines heiligen Leibs und Bluts theilhafftig werden umb deines heiligen Leidens und Sterbens unnd dieses deines Heiligen Testaments Ehre willen, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Over and above all this we beseech thee, O Lord Jesu Christ, who art the founder and upholder of this Sacrament, that thou wouldest richly impart unto us, who appear here to receive the same, thy Holy Spirit according to thy manifold promise, who may strengthen and keep our hearts in undoubting faith in thy words, in true knowledge, repentance and sorrow for our sins, and in firm trust in thy sole satisfaction for the same, that we may be partakers, not unworthily but worthily, of the precious pledges of thy holy Body and Blood; for the honour of thy holy sufferings and death and of this thy holy Testament. Amen.

**A.15 Blessing**

*Witnesses:* Neckarbischofsheim 1560.

**Rubric (German).** Appendix.

**Rubric (English).** Appendix.

**Prayer (German).** Glaubt, so seyt ir erhert im himmel, wie uns der Herr zugesagt hat: Was ir bitet in ewerm gebet, glaubt nur, das irs Empfangen werdet, so wirts euch werden. Hierbey gesegne und behüte euch der herr, er erzaige euch sein angesicht und erbarme sich über euch und gebe euch seinen ewigen friden. Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Believe, and ye are heard in heaven, as the Lord hath promised us: Whatsoever ye ask in your prayer, only believe that ye shall receive it, and it shall be done unto you. Herewith the Lord bless you and keep you; he show you his face and have mercy upon you, and give you his everlasting peace. Amen.

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## 6.5 Family B1: Württemberg long form

Brenz's bidding-plus-collect scheme in its ducal form: a preface on prayer (Mt 18:19, 1 Tim 2), then biddings each followed by a collect; used chiefly on high feasts. Spread through Pfalz-Neuburg 1554 to the Palatinate, Zweibrücken, Veldenz and Leiningen.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Württemberg 1553, long form.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** preface, then bidding + collect for each intention.
- **Place in the service (Württemberg 1553):** On Sundays and feast days immediately after the sermon ("auff die Sontag unnd andere Feyertag gleich nach der predig"); the Litany is the second form of the common prayer.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1553 | Württemberg, Große Kirchenordnung (Brenz) | Duchy of Württemberg | Sehling 16, I/29, pp. 256–258 | bidding + collect |
| 1556 | Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Ottheinrich) | Electoral Palatinate | Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Ottheinrichs, pp. 151–153 | bidding + collect |
| 1557 | Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Wolfgang) | Palatinate-Zweibrücken (and Neuburg) | Sehling 18, I/5, pp. 193–195 | bidding + collect |

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1566 | Leiningen-Westerburg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Philipp) | County of Leiningen-Westerburg | Sehling 19, IV/3, pp. 254–255 | preface + bidding + headed collects |
| 1574 | Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Georg Johann) | Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein) | Sehling 18, II/8, pp. 505–508 | bidding + collect |

Each bid ends "Bittend also:" and each collect "durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.", following the family's own majority (Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

B1.2 to B1.4 are not one sequence but two local insertions after the preface. B1.2 is Kurpfalz 1556's lead-in to the open confession and absolution, which that order places here. B1.3 and B1.4 are Pfalz-Veldenz 1574's own confession and absolution.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 no. 9 (Peace).

**Sequence:** B1.1 Exhortation / preface > B1.2 Confession of sins > B1.3 Confession of sins > B1.4 Confession of sins > B1.5 The Church > B1.6 Civil authority > B1.7 The afflicted > B1.8 The erring & unbelievers > B1.9 Peace > B1.10 Enemies > B1.11 Women with child > B1.12 Fruits of the earth > B1.13 Lord's Prayer.

#### B1.1 Exhortation / preface

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Rubric (German).** Die vorrede des gmeinen Gebets.

**Rubric (English).** The preface of the common prayer.

**Bid (German).** Nach dem wir beieinander in gottes namen versamlet seind und uns bevolhen ist, das wir Gott in aller unser nott sollen anruffen, auch für meniglich unser fürbitt thun, zu welchem wir die zusagung unsers lieben Herrn Christi haben: Wa zwen under euch eins werden auff erden, warumb es ist, das sie bitten wöllen, das soll inen von meinem vatter im himmel widerfaren, und: Bittet, so würdt euch gegeben, suchet, so werdet ir finden, klopfft an, so würdt euch auffgethon.

**Bid (English).** Forasmuch as we are gathered together in God’s name, and it is commanded us that we should call upon God in all our need and also make our intercession for every man, whereunto we have the promise of our dear Lord Christ: Where two of you shall agree on earth as touching any thing that they shall ask, it shall be done for them of my Father which is in heaven; and: Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

#### B1.2 Confession of sins

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1556.

**Bid (German).** Hierauf, dieweil wir für dem thron göttlicher majestat mit tröstlichem gewissen und sicherem glauben in unserm gebet nicht kommen mögen noch dörfen, wir seyen dann zuvor mit Gott versönet und von ime mit genaden aufgenommen, wir kummen aber durch keinen andern weg zur versönung mit Gott, dann so wir unsere sünde erkhennen und glauben, das uns die sünde von wegen des eingebornen sons Gottes, unsers lieben herren Jesu Christi, vergeben und nachgelassen sein, so lasst uns anfencklich unsere sünde vor Gott bekhennen und hernach die absolution von den sünden empfahen, sprechend also: Ich armer sünder etc. ut supra.

**Bid (English).** Hereupon, forasmuch as we neither can nor may come before the throne of the divine majesty in our prayer with a comforted conscience and sure faith, except we be first reconciled with God and received of him into grace; and we come by no other way unto reconciliation with God, but that we acknowledge our sins and believe that our sins are forgiven and remitted us for the sake of the only-begotten Son of God, our dear Lord Jesus Christ: let us therefore first confess our sins before God and thereafter receive the absolution from our sins, saying thus: I, poor sinner, etc., as above.

#### B1.3 Confession of sins

*Witnesses:* Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Rubric (German).** Beicht und bekantnus.

**Rubric (English).** Confession and acknowledgement.

**Bid (German).** Damit unnser gebett nit von Gott veracht und verworffen werde, als das auß unrainem, unbußfertigem hertzen herfliesse, so wöllen wir von aller erst dem allmechtigen unnsere Sünde und missethat bekhennen mit wahrer rew und Laidt und im Namen seines geliebten Sohns Jesu Christi umb verzeyhung auß wahrem glauben pitten. Darumb so erhebt ewer hertzen und sprecht mit mir dise offne Beicht:

**Bid (English).** That our prayer be not despised and cast away of God, as flowing out of an unclean, impenitent heart, we will first of all confess our sins and misdeeds unto the Almighty with true repentance and sorrow, and in the name of his beloved Son Jesus Christ pray for pardon out of true faith. Therefore lift up your hearts and say with me this open confession:

**Prayer (German).** Ich armer, elender, sündiger Mensch bekhenne vor Gott, meinem schöpfer unnd Erlöser, das ich laider offt unnd dickh sehr schwerlich gesündigt hab, nicht allein mit groben eusserlichen wortten unnd werckhen, sonnder vilmehr mit innerlicher, angeborner blindheit, schwachheit, zweifflung, ungedult, haß und Neidt, Geitz, Stoltz und hochmuth und mit andern bösen tückhen, die mein himelischer Vatter wol an mir erkhandt, und ichs laider nit so volkhommenlich erkhennen khan. Sie rewen mich aber von hertzen und seind mir laidt, begehre auch von hertzen gnad und verzeyhung von Gott umb seines geliebten Sohnes willen, unnsers herrn und erlösers Jesu Christi, der sein unschuldiges bluth für die sünde der gantzen welt vergossen hat.

**Prayer (English).** I, a poor, wretched, sinful man, confess before God, my Creator and Redeemer, that I, alas, have oft and many times sinned right grievously, not only with gross outward words and works, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, weakness, doubting, impatience, hatred and envy, covetousness, pride and haughtiness, and with other evil wiles, which my heavenly Father well knoweth in me, and which I, alas, cannot so perfectly know. But they repent me from my heart and grieve me; I desire also from my heart grace and pardon of God, for the sake of his beloved Son, our Lord and Redeemer Jesus Christ, who hath shed his innocent blood for the sins of the whole world.

**B1.4 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Rubric (German).** Absolution.

**Rubric (English).** Absolution.

**Prayer (German).** Der allmechtige, Barmhertzige Gott hat sich unnser erbarmet, vergibt uns warhafftiglich all unnsere Sünde umb seines lieben sohns willen, unnsers herrn Jesu Christi, den er umb unnsertwillen in den dodt gegeben, und hat macht geben, khinder Gottes zuwerden allen, die an seinen Namen glauben, gibt uns darzu seinen hailigen Geist, uff das wir glauben und seelig werden. Das verleyehe uns Gott, Vatter, Sohn und heiliger Gaist. Amen.

**Prayer (English).** The almighty, merciful God hath had mercy upon us, and forgiveth us truly all our sins for the sake of his dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ, whom he gave into death for our sakes, and hath given power to become the children of God to all that believe on his name; he giveth us moreover his Holy Spirit, that we may believe and be saved. This grant us God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen.

**B1.5 The Church**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Bid (German).** Hierauff laßt uns auß warem vertrawen zu Göttlicher barmherzigkeit durch unsern Herren Jesum Christum bitten für die gmein christlich kirch und derselben diener. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Hereupon let us, out of true confidence in the divine mercy, through our Lord Jesus Christ, pray for the common Christian Church and the ministers thereof. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** O allmechtiger ewiger, güttiger Gott und vatter unsers Herrn Jesu Christi, der uns ernstlich bevolhen hat, das wir dich umb Arbeitter in deine ernd bitten sollent, wir bitten dein grundlose barmhertzigkeit, du wöllest uns rechtgeschaffne

leerer und diener deines Göttlichen worts zuschicken, und denselben dein heilsames wort in ir hertz und mund geben, das sie deinen bevelch trewlich außrichten unnd nichts predigen, das deinem heiligen wort entgegen seie, auff das wir durch dein himmelisch, ewig wort ermanet, gelert, gespeißt, getröst und gesterckt werden, und thun, was dir gefällig und uns fruchtbarlich ist. Gib, Herr, deiner heiligen Christenheit deinen geist und göttliche weißheit, das dein wort under uns lauff und wachsse unnd mit aller freidigkeit, wie sichs gebürt, geprediget unnd dein heilige, Christliche gemein dardurch gebessert werde, auff das wir mit bestendigem glauben dir dienen und in erkanntnuß deines Namens biß an das end verharren, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath first commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christendom thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end. Amen.

**B1.6 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für die weltlich Oberkeit.

**Rubric (English).** For the temporal magistrates.

**Bid (German).** Lassend uns trewlich bitten auß bevelch unsers Herren Jesu Christi und seiner Aposteln für alle weltliche Oberkeit, das wir ein rüwigs, stils leben in aller Gottseligkeit füren mögen. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us faithfully pray, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ and of his Apostles, for all temporal magistrates, that we may lead a quiet and still life in all godliness. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, ewiger Gott, in welches hand besteet aller menschen gewalt und Oberkeit, von dir zur straff der bösen und wolfart der frommen eingesetzt, in welches hand auch steend alle recht und gesetz aller recht auff erden, wir bitten dich, sihe gnediglich auff deine diener, den Römischen Kaiser, alle König, fürsten und ordenlich Oberkeit und sonderlich auff unsern gnedigen Landsfürsten und herrn, auch alle seine Räth und Amptleut, damit sie das weltlich schwerdt, inen von dir bevolhen, nach deinem bevelch in deiner forcht füren mögen, erleucht und erhalte sie bei deinem Göttlichen Namen, gib in, lieber Herr, weißheit und verstand und ein fridlich Regiment, auff das sie alle ire underthonen im frid, ruhe und einigkeit beschirmen und regieren, erlengere inen, O Gott unsers heils, ir tag, auff das wir under irer Herrschaft deinen Göttlichen Namen sampt inen heiligen unnd preisen mögen, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, in whose hand standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of the wicked and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all realms upon earth: we beseech thee, look graciously upon thy servants, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and lawful magistrates, and especially upon our gracious prince and lord of this land, and also all his counsellors and officers, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, according to thy commandment in thy fear. Enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may defend and rule all their subjects in peace, rest and unity; and prolong their days, O God of our salvation, that under their dominion we together with them may hallow and praise thy divine name; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**B1.7 The afflicted**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für allerlei bekümmernus und anfechtung.

**Rubric (English).** For all manner of trouble and temptation.

**Bid (German).** Lassend uns bitten für alle die, so in bekümmernus unnd anfechtung von wegen kranckheit, theurung, krieg, gefäncknuß, pestilentz und mit allerlei widerwertigkeit beschwerdt und beladen sein, das inen Gott hilff und beistand in irer nott gnediglich beweisen wölle. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us pray for all them that are in trouble and temptation by reason of sickness, dearth, war, imprisonment, pestilence, and are burdened and laden with all manner of adversity, that God would graciously show them help and succour in their need. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** O Allmechtiger Herr Gott, der du der ellenden seufftzen nicht verschmechst und der betrübten hertzen verlangen nit verachtest, sihe doch an unser gebett, welches wir dir in unser nott fürbringen und erhöre uns gnädiglich, das alles, so beide, von teuffel und menschen, wider uns strebt, zu nicht und von der gnad deiner gütte zertrent werde, auf das wir von aller anfechtung unverseret, dir in deiner gemein dancken und dich all zeit loben, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** O almighty Lord God, who despisest not the sighing of the wretched, and settest not at nought the desire of the sorrowful hearts: look thou upon our prayer, which we bring before thee in our need, and hear us graciously, that all that striveth against us, both from the devil and from men, may be brought to nought and by the grace of thy goodness be scattered; that we, being hurt by no temptation, may give thanks unto thee in thy congregation and praise thee evermore; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**B1.8 The erring & unbelievers**

*Witnesses:* Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Rubric (German).** Für die, so in Irtumb des glaubens, das sie Gott gnediglich bekheren etc.

**Rubric (English).** For them that are in error of the faith, that God would graciously convert them, etc.

**Prayer (German).** Herr Gott, himelischer Vatter, der du wilt, das alle Menschen zu deiner erkhantnus khommen und seelig werden. Wir pitten dich ernstlich und mit gantzem hertzen, du wöllest alle, so vom Christlichen glauben abgewichen oder sonnst mit etlichen stuckhen irrig und mit falscher lehr behafft und verfieret seind, vätterlich heimbsuchen unnd wider bringen zu erkantnus ires irthumbs, das sie ein lust und gefallen gewinnen an deiner bestendigen, einfaltigen, ewigen warheit, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Lord God, heavenly Father, who willest that all men come to the knowledge of thee and be saved: we pray thee earnestly and with our whole heart that thou wouldest visit in fatherly wise all them that are fallen away from the Christian faith, or else are erring in certain articles and are possessed and led astray with false doctrine, and bring them again to the knowledge of their error, that they may win delight and pleasure in thy steadfast, simple, eternal truth; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**B1.9 Peace**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für ein gemeinen frid.

**Rubric (English).** For the common peace.

**Bid (German).** Laßt uns auch gar ernstlich umb einen gemeinen Landtfriden bitten, das der recht Gotsdienst under uns auffwachse und Christenliche zucht zuneme. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray right earnestly for a common peace in the land, that the true service of God may grow up among us and Christian discipline increase. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, ewiger Gott, ein Künig der ehren und ein Herr himmels unnd der erden, durch wölches Geist alle ding Regiert, durch welches versehung alle ding geordnet werden, der du bist ein Gott des fridens, von dem allein alle einigkeit zu uns kommet. Wir bitten dich durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, du wöllest uns unser sünd vergeben und mit

deinem Göttlichen frid und einigkeit begnaden, damit wir in forcht und zittern dir dienen zu lob unnd preiß deines Namens, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; who art a God of peace, from whom alone all unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thee in fear and trembling, to the laud and praise of thy name. Amen.

**B1.10 Enemies**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 lack the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für die feind.

**Rubric (English).** For the enemies.

**Bid (German).** Laßt uns auch bitten für unsere feind, das Gott sie mit gnaden bedencke und inen, was zu irem heil nutzlich und notdurfftig ist, gnediglich verleihen wölle. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for our enemies, that God would remember them with grace and graciously vouchsafe them that which is profitable and needful to their salvation. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, Ewiger Gott, der du uns bevolhen hast, das wir unsere feind lieb haben sollen, denen, die uns beleidigen, guts thun und für unsere verfolger bitten, wir schreien ernstlich zu dir, das du alle unsere feind wöllest gnediglich heimsuchen, inen ware reuwe irer sünden verleihen, auch mit uns und der gantzen Christenheit ein freuntliches, gotsförchtigs, einhelligs gemüt und hertz geben, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, who hast commanded us that we should love our enemies, do good to them that hurt us, and pray for our persecutors: we cry earnestly unto thee that thou wouldest graciously visit all our enemies, vouchsafe them true repentance of their sins, and give them, together with us and the whole of Christendom, a friendly, God-fearing, and single mind and heart; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**B1.11 Women with child**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 lack the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für alle Schwangere weiber.

**Rubric (English).** For all women with child.

**Bid (German).** Lassen uns auch bitten für alle schwangere weiber, das sie Gott gnediglichen von kindesbanden erlösen wölle. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for all women with child, that God would graciously deliver them from the bonds of childbirth. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, ewiger gott und vatter, ein schöpffer aller ding, der du Mann und Weib gnediglich gesegnet hast und dem weib, iren schmertzen zu zugeberen, zu einem heiligen creutz gesegnet hast, wir bitten dich, güttiger vatter, du wöllest die früchten ires leibs erhalten und bewaren und under dem Creutz in der bekümmerlichen geburt nicht verderben, sonder gnädiglich unnd mit freuden deiner hilff empfinden lassen, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God and Father, a Creator of all things, who hast graciously blessed man and woman, and hast blessed unto the woman her pains in bearing to be an holy cross: we beseech thee, gracious Father, that thou wouldest keep and preserve the fruits of their womb, and not let it perish under the cross in the sorrowful travail, but graciously and with joy make them to feel thy help; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**B1.12 Fruits of the earth**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574. *Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 lacks the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Für die Früchten der Erden.

**Rubric (English).** For the fruits of the earth.

**Bid (German).** Lassend uns auch bitten für die Frücht der erden, das sie Gott wölle segnen und uns dieselben, in seinem gehorsam zugniessen, gnädiglich verleihen. Bittend also:

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for the fruits of the earth, that God would bless them and graciously vouchsafe them unto us, to enjoy the same in obedience unto him. Pray ye thus:

**Prayer (German).** Allmächtiger, ewiger Gott, der du durch dein wort alle ding erschaffest unnd gesegnest, wir bitten dich, das du dein wort, unsern Herrn Jhesum Christum, in unser hertz pflantzest, dardurch an uns gesegnet werde mit fruchtbarer wachsung unnd Göttlichem gebrauch alles, was uns zur leiblichen notturfft dienet, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, who by thy word createst and blessest all things: we beseech thee that thou wouldest plant thy Word, our Lord Jesus Christ, in our heart, whereby all that serveth us for our bodily need may be blessed unto us with fruitful increase and godly use; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

#### B1.13 Lord's Prayer

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574.

**Bid (German).** Lassend uns auch bitten für alles das, darfür unser Herr Gott wil gebetten sein, sprecht: Vatter unser, etc.

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for all that for which our Lord God will be prayed, saying: Our Father, etc.

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### 6.6 Family B2: Württemberg short form

The same intentions compressed into a single continuous prayer ("Allmächtiger, ewiger Gott, himmlischer Vater …") after a brief exhortation; the ordinary Sunday form. The most widely copied general prayer in the corpus, reaching Saxony (1580), Magdeburg, Strasbourg, Sayn, Nassau and the Ysenburg counties.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Württemberg 1553, short form.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** exhortation + one continuous prayer.
- **Place in the service (Württemberg 1553):** After the sermon, when time does not allow the long form to be read.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1553 | Württemberg, Große Kirchenordnung (Brenz) | Duchy of Württemberg | Sehling 16, I/29, pp. 261–262 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1556 | Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Ottheinrich) | Electoral Palatinate | Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Ottheinrichs, pp. 157–159 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1557 | Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Wolfgang) | Palatinate-Zweibrücken (and Neuburg) | Sehling 18, I/5, pp. 195–196 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1559 | Rothenburg ob der Tauber, Kirchenordnung | Rothenburg ob der Tauber (Imperial city) | Sehling 11, VI.1, pp. 587–588 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1562 | Erzstift Magdeburg, Visitationsordnung 1562 | Archbishopric of Magdeburg | Sehling 2, Erzbisthum Magdeburg Nr. 1, p. 420 | prescription of contents (indirect speech) |

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | (Administrator Sigismund of Brandenburg) | | | |
| 1574 | Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Georg Johann) | Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein) | Sehling 18, II/8, pp. 508–509 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1578 | Hohenlohe, Kirchenordnung | County of Hohenlohe | Sehling 15, Nr. 25, pp. 263–264 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1579 | Nördlingen, Kirchenordnung | Nördlingen (Imperial city) | Sehling 12, VIII.7, pp. 367–368 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1580 | Kursachsen, Kirchenordnung (Kurfürst August) | Electorate of Saxony | Sehling 1, II. Theil, Nr. 40, pp. 370–371 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1582 | Ysenburg-Ronneburg, Agende | County of Ysenburg-Ronneburg | Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Ronneburg Nr. 3, pp. 575–576 | confession + continuous prayer |
| 1588 | Ysenburg-Birstein, Kirchenordnung | County of Ysenburg-Büdingen-Birstein | Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Birstein Nr. 14, pp. 621–622 | exhortation + confession + continuous prayer |
| 1590 | Sayn, Kirchenordnung 1590 (Graf Heinrich IV.) | County of Sayn | Sehling 19, V/18, pp. 408–410 | preface + continuous prayer |
| 1598 | Straßburg, Kirchenordnung (9 April 1598) | Strasbourg (Imperial city) | Sehling 20/1, Nr. 61, pp. 588–589 | exhortation + continuous prayer |
| 1603 | Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, Kirchenordnung [nach 1603] | Wild- and Rhinegraviate (Salm-Kyrburg, Dhaun, Grumbach) | Sehling 19, VII/21, pp. 622–623 | exhortation + confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1605 | Pfalz-Veldenz, Kirchenordnung Lützelstein | Palatinate-Veldenz (Lützelstein) | Sehling 18, II/11, pp. 585–586 | continuous prayer |
| 1618 | Nassau-Weilburg (Nassau-Saarbrücken), Kirchenordnung und Agende 1617/1618 | Counties of Nassau-Weilburg and Saarbrücken | Sehling 10, I/Nassau-Weilburg Nr. 1 (appendix: KO 1617, Agende 1618), p. 314 | continuous prayer |
| 1618 | Rothenberg, Vereinigung, wie es mit den kirchenactibus soll gehalten werden | Ganerbschaft Rothenberg (Franconia) | Sehling 13, V.1–2, pp. 548–549 | continuous prayer |

Magdeburg 1562 prescribes the contents of the prayer in indirect speech ("das er auch der weltlichen obrigkeit …"). Where no other witness has a bid, its sentences fill the bid column. B2.2 is its opening, and the bids of B2.6 and B2.9 are its words. They are paraphrases of the prayer, not words said to the people.

The confession and absolution (B2.3, B2.4) are those of the Ysenburg orders of 1582 and 1588 and the Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603. B2.12, B2.13 and B2.15 each come from a single witness (Rothenberg 1618, Rothenburg 1559, Nördlingen 1579) and stand where that order has them.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Hohenlohe 1578 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Nördlingen 1579 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Sayn 1590 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Strassburg 1598 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Strassburg 1598 no. 8 (Special intercessions); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 1 (Exhortation / preface); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 3 (Confession of sins); Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 no. 10 (Lord's Prayer); Lützelstein 1605 no. 1 (Special intercessions).

**Sequence:** B2.1 Exhortation / preface > B2.2 Thanksgiving > B2.3 Confession of sins > B2.4 Confession of sins > B2.5 The Church > B2.6 Civil authority > B2.7 Enemies > B2.8 The erring & unbelievers > B2.9 The afflicted > B2.10 Fruits of the earth > B2.11 Conclusion > B2.12 Communicants > B2.13 Lord's Prayer > B2.14 Lord's Prayer > B2.15 Special intercessions.

**B2.1 Exhortation / preface**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Nördlingen 1579 and Kursachsen 1580.

**Rubric (German).** Ein kürzere form des gemeinen gebets. Nachdem sich aber zu zeitten etlich zufäll begeben, das die gebett nach der leng nicht wol erzeelt mögen werden, So mag alsdann das volgendt gebett, darinn alles anligen der kirchen kurtzlich begriffen, nach der predig fürgesprochen werden:

**Rubric (English).** A shorter form of the common prayer. But forasmuch as it cometh to pass at times that the prayers cannot well be rehearsed at length, then may the following prayer, wherein all the concerns of the Church are briefly comprehended, be said after the sermon:

**Bid (German).** Ir geliebten in Christo, dieweil wir alle glider eines leibs seind, welches haupt Christus ist, so soll sich je ein glid des andern annemen und für einander bitten, das sollen wir auß bevelch unsers herrn Christi und seines heiligen Apostels von hertzen gern thun. Bittendt also:

**Bid (English).** Dearly beloved in Christ, forasmuch as we are all members of one body, whereof Christ is the head, so ought one member to take the part of another and to pray one for another; and this we should do gladly from the heart, by the commandment of our Lord Christ and of his holy Apostle. Pray ye thus:

**B2.2 Thanksgiving**

*Witnesses:* Magdeburg 1562.

**Rubric (German).** Wie sie das gemeine gebet halten. (Am Rande: Erinnerung des gemeinen gebets halben.)

**Rubric (English).** How they hold the common prayer. (In the margin: Reminder concerning the common prayer.)

**Bid (German).** Und sollen die kirchen diener auf den dorfern und in den kleinen stedten alhier von unsern visitatorn erinnert werden, das sie in dem gemeinen gebet, so alzeit nach der predigt geschicht, den barmherzigen gott danken für die offenbarung und erhaltung seines gottlichen worts

**Bid (English).** And the ministers of the Church in the villages and in the small towns here shall be reminded by our visitors that in the common prayer, which is always made after the sermon, they give thanks unto the merciful God for the revelation and preservation of his divine word,

**B2.3 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 and Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603. *The bid is in Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 only.*

**Bid (German).** Bekennet mit mir vor Gott ewer sunde, sprecht vonn hertzenn:

**Bid (English).** Confess with me your sins before God; say from the heart:

**Prayer (German).** Herr Gott, himlischer vatter, ich armer, sundiger mensch bekenne mich vor dir, daß ich leyder schwerlich unndt viel wieder dich gesundiget habe mit wortenn, werckenn, gedanckenn, thun unndt lassenn, wie du es an mir, o Gott, erkennest, undt ich leyder nicht bekennenn kann. Es reuet mich undt ist mir leydt vonn hertzenn. Ich beger gnadt unndt vergebung meiner sundenn durch Jesum Christum, deinen liebenn sohnn.

**Prayer (English).** Lord God, heavenly Father, I, a poor sinful man, confess before thee that I, alas, have sinned grievously and much against thee with words, works, thoughts, doing and leaving undone, as thou, O God, knowest it in me, and I, alas, cannot confess it. It repenteth me and grieveth me from my heart. I desire grace and forgiveness of my sins through Jesus Christ thy dear Son.

**B2.4 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1588.

**Prayer (German).** Allenn denjenigen, so ihnen ihre sundt von herzen lassenn leydt sein, sich vor Gottes zorn furchtenn unndt erschreckenn, begeren aber gnadt und glauben ann Jesum Christum, gedenckenn, ihr leben zubessern, den verkundige ich auß dem bevelch Gottes, daß sich Gott irer erbarmen, die sunde verzeihenn undt daß ewige lebenn schenckenn will umb Jesu Christi, seines liebenn sohns, willenn. Die aber ihre sundt nicht erkennen, Gottes zorn nicht furchtenn, sonder in sunden mit unbußfertigkeitt verharrenn undt fortfahrenn, glauben auch nicht an Jesum Christum, sonder verlassen sich uf ihr eygene werck unndt wirdigkeit oder auf etwaß anders ausserhalb Christo, uber denen bleibt der zorn Gottes biß zur zeitt ihrer besserung.

**Prayer (English).** To all them that are heartily sorry for their sins, fear and are affrighted before God's wrath, but desire grace and believe on Jesus Christ, and purpose to amend their life, unto them I declare by the commandment of God that God will have mercy upon them, pardon their sins, and give them eternal life for the sake of Jesus Christ his dear Son. But they that acknowledge not their sins, fear not God's wrath, but continue and go on in sins with impenitence, and believe not on Jesus Christ, but trust in their own works and worthiness or in aught else apart from Christ: upon them the wrath of God abideth until the time of their amendment.

**B2.5 The Church**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588 and Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

**Bid (German).** Lasset unns bettenn:

**Bid (English).** Let us pray:

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger, barmhertziger, ewiger Gott und vatter, ein herr himels und der erden, wir bitten dich hertziglich, du wöllest dein heilige kirche mit iren dienern durch den heiligen geist regieren, auff das sie bei der rechtgeschaffenen waid deines Allmechtigen und ewigen worts erhalten werden, dardurch der glaub gegen dir gesterckt und die lieb gegen allen menschen in uns erwachse und zuneme.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, merciful, everlasting God and Father, a Lord of heaven and of earth: we beseech thee heartily that thou wouldest govern thy holy Church with her ministers by the Holy Ghost, that they may be kept in the right and true pasture of thine almighty and everlasting word, whereby faith toward thee may be strengthened, and love toward all men may spring up and increase in us.

**B2.6 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

**Bid (German).** das er auch der weltlichen obrigkeit, dem romischen keiser, allen christlichen konigen, churfursten, fursten und hern, insonderheit aber uns als den landesfursten, unser freundlichen herzlieben gemahl, junger herschaft und freulein, auch dem ganzen hochloblichen chur- und furstlichem hause Brandenburg, langes leben, bestendige gesundheit und gluckliche regirunge sambt aller zeitlichen und ewigen wolfart, desgleichen allen unsern rethen und ambtleuten vorstand, gnade und einigkeit vorleihen wolle, die unterthanen nach seinem gottlichen willen und wolgefallen zu regiren, auf das die gerechtigkeit gefordert und die bosheit gehindert und gestraft werde, damit wir in stiller ruhe und gutem friede, als christen gebueret, unser leben volstrecken mugen,

**Bid (English).** that he would also vouchsafe unto the temporal magistrates, the Roman Emperor, all Christian kings, Electors, princes and lords, but especially unto us as prince of the land, our kind and dearly beloved consort, the young lordship and

damsels, and also the whole most laudable Electoral and princely house of Brandenburg, long life, abiding health and prosperous government, together with all temporal and eternal welfare; and likewise unto all our counsellors and officers understanding, grace and unity to rule the subjects according to his divine will and good pleasure, that righteousness may be furthered and wickedness hindered and punished, that we may accomplish our life in quiet rest and good peace, as becometh Christians;

**Prayer (German).** Wöllest auch der weltlichen Oberkeit, dem Römischen Kaiser, allen Königen, Fürsten und herrn, insonderheit aber unserm gnedigen herrn und Landsfürsten, auch dem gantzen hauß Wirtemberg sampt allen iren Räthen und Amptleuten gnad und einigkeit verleihen, die underthonen nach deinem Göttlichen willen und wolgefallen zu regieren, auff das die gerechtigkeit gefürdert, die boßheit verhindert und gestrafft werde, darmit wir in stiller ruw und gutem friden, als Christen gebürt, unser leben volstrecken mögen.

**Prayer (English).** Vouchsafe also unto the temporal magistrates, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and lords, but especially unto our gracious lord and prince of this land, and also the whole house of Württemberg, together with all their counsellors and officers, grace and unity to rule the subjects according to thy divine will and good pleasure; that righteousness may be furthered, and wickedness hindered and punished, that we may accomplish our life in quiet rest and good peace, as becometh Christians.

**B2.7 Enemies**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

**Prayer (German).** Das auch unsere feind und widersächer ablassen und sich mit uns fridlich und sanfftiglich zuleben begeben wöllen.

**Prayer (English).** That our enemies and adversaries also may desist, and yield themselves to live with us peaceably and gently.

**B2.8 The erring & unbelievers**

*Witnesses:* Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 and Lützelstein 1605.

**Prayer (German).** Unnd alle, so irren, verfüert und abtrünnig sein, wöllestu, o güettiger Gott, bringen zur warheitt deines wortts und erkantnus deines heiligen Nahmens.

**Prayer (English).** And all that err, are led astray, and are apostate, wilt thou, O gracious God, bring to the truth of thy word and the knowledge of thy holy name.

**B2.9 The afflicted**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Magdeburg 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618. *The bid is in Magdeburg 1562 only. Magdeburg 1562 lacks the prayer.*

**Bid (German).** und wie sonst die form des gemeinen gebets weiter zu geschehen pflegt, vor die fruchte der erden, vor alle betrubte, arme, kranke, so vom teufel oder menschen angefochten, vor die so umb seines heiligen namens und der warheit willen gefangen oder sonst verfolgung leiden und was dergleichen trubsal und beschwerung mehr sein.

**Bid (English).** and, as the form of the common prayer is further wont to go, for the fruits of the earth, for all the sorrowful, poor and sick that are assailed by the devil or by men, for them that for his holy name's sake and for the truth's sake are taken captive or otherwise suffer persecution, and whatsoever more there be of like tribulation and burden.

**Prayer (German).** Alle die, so in trübsal, armut, kranckheit, kindsbanden und anderer anfechtungen seind, auch die, so umb deines heiligen namens und der warheit willen angefochten, gefangen oder sonst verfolgung leiden, tröst sie, o Gott, mit deinem heiligen geist, das sie solches alles für deinen väterlichen willen auffnemen und erkennen.

**Prayer (English).** All them that are in tribulation, poverty, sickness, the bonds of childbirth, and other temptation, and them also that for thy holy name's sake and for the truth's sake are assailed, taken captive, or otherwise suffer persecution: comfort them, O God, with thy Holy Spirit, that they may receive and acknowledge all this as thy fatherly will.

**B2.10 Fruits of the earth**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

**Prayer (German).** Wöllest uns auch alle frucht der erden, zur leiblicher notturft gehörig, mit fruchtbarer wachssung geraten unnd gedeihen lassen.

**Prayer (English).** Cause also all the fruits of the earth that pertain to our bodily need to prosper and thrive for us with fruitful increase.

**B2.11 Conclusion**

*Witnesses:* Württemberg 1553, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Rothenburg 1559, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Nördlingen 1579, Kursachsen 1580, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Sayn 1590, Strassburg 1598, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603, Lützelstein 1605, Nassau-Weilburg 1618 and Rothenberg 1618.

**Prayer (German).** Auch bitten wir für alles, darfür du, ewiger Gott, gebetten sein wilt, das du uns sollichs gnediglich verleihest durch das bitter leiden und sterben Christi Jesu, deines einigen Sons, unsers geliebten herrn und heilands, welcher mit dir und dem heiligen geist lebt und regiert, gleicher Gott, hochgelobt, in ewigkeit, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** We pray also for all that for which thou, everlasting God, wilt be prayed, that thou wouldest graciously vouchsafe us the same, through the bitter suffering and death of Christ Jesus, thine only Son, our beloved Lord and Saviour, who with thee and the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, equal God, highly praised, for ever. Amen.

**B2.12 Communicants**

*Witnesses:* Rothenberg 1618.

**Rubric (German).** Nota. Wenn communicanten vorhanden sein, soll man auch für die zu bitten nicht unterlassen, damit sie das heilige abendmal in warer erkantnus und reu ihrer sünden, in seligmachetem glauben an Christum und in einen christlichen vorsatz, ihr leben zu bessern, zum leben empfahen mögen.

**Rubric (English).** Note. When there are communicants, one shall not omit to pray for them also, that they may receive the holy Supper unto life in true knowledge and repentance of their sins, in saving faith in Christ, and in a Christian purpose to amend their life.

**B2.13 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Rothenburg 1559.

**Rubric (German).** Und sprech ein jedes ein Vater unser darauf!

**Rubric (English).** And let every one say an Our Father thereupon.

**B2.14 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Hohenlohe 1578, Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1582, Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Lützelstein 1605 and Nassau-Weilburg 1618. *Hohenlohe 1578 lacks the prayer.*

**Prayer (German).** Vatter unnser, etc.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father, etc.

**B2.15 Special intercessions**

*Witnesses:* Nördlingen 1579.

**Rubric (German).** Darauf die sondere zufellige not als kranke, verkündigung der eheleut, feirtage etc. zu vermelden und mit dem Vater unser zu beschließen sampt dem segen:

**Rubric (English).** Thereupon the special needs that befall, as the sick, the publishing of the married folk, feast days, etc., are to be announced, and it is to be concluded with the Our Father, together with the blessing:

**Prayer (German).** Die gnade unsers Herrn Jesu Christi und die liebe Gottes und die gemeinschaft des Heiligen Geistes sei mit euch allen! Amen.

**Prayer (English).** The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen.

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## 6.7 Family C: Bidding exhortation (Strasbourg type)

A bidding exhortation in the Strasbourg manner: the minister tells the people what to pray for, item by item, without addressing God, and ends with the Our Father.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573):** After the sermon; then a psalm is sung by school and congregation, followed by a collect and the blessing. The pastor is to refer to the sermon just preached and to present needs (war, plague, dearth) in the common prayer.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1573 | Hanau-Lichtenberg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Philipp IV.) | County of Hanau-Lichtenberg (Alsace) | Sehling 20/2, Hanau-Lichtenberg Nr. 6, pp. 52–53 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |

**Sequence:** C.1 Exhortation / preface > C.2 The Word & its fruit > C.3 Civil authority > C.4 All estates / households > C.5 Fruits of the earth > C.6 The afflicted > C.7 Special intercessions > C.8 Lord's Prayer.

**C.1 Exhortation / preface**

**Rubric (German).** Nach der Predig geschehe das gemein Gebet auff folgende weiß:

**Rubric (English).** After the sermon let the common prayer be made on this wise:

**Bid (German).** Lieben freund, Dieweil wir beyeinander versamlet sein und Gottes wort gehöret haben, so wöllen wir alle not der gantzen Christenheit unserm Herrgott fürtragen, ihne bitten, er wöll uns gnedig und barmhertzig sein, alles geben, was uns nutz und not ist, zur leibes notturfft und zur seelen seligkeit:

**Bid (English).** Dear friends, forasmuch as we are gathered together and have heard God’s word, we will lay all the need of the whole of Christendom before our Lord God, and pray him that he would be gracious and merciful unto us, and give all that is profitable and needful for us, for the necessity of the body and for the salvation of the soul:

**C.2 The Word & its fruit**

**Bid (German).** Am ersten so bittet für das Geistlich, das unser lieber Herrgott uns sein heiligs wort wölle lassen predigen und gnad verleihen, das wir solches gerne hören, mit dem hertzen glauben und unser leben darnach richten, auch alle die jenigen, so von solchs Worts wegen in jamer, elend und widerwertigkeit stecken, trösten, stercken und auß allem jamer und elend

erretten. Er wölle auch alle, so noch in finsternuß, irrthumb und abgötterey stecken, gnediglich durch sein Wort und Heiligen Geist erleuchten und zu erkantnuß der warheit bringen, auff daß sie mit uns und wir mit ihnen mögen selig werden.

**Bid (English).** First, pray ye for the spiritual estate: that our dear Lord God would let his holy word be preached unto us, and vouchsafe grace that we may gladly hear the same, believe it with the heart, and order our life thereafter; and that he would comfort, strengthen, and deliver out of all misery and woe all those that for the sake of this Word are in misery, woe and adversity. That he would also graciously enlighten by his Word and Holy Spirit all that are yet in darkness, error and idolatry, and bring them to the knowledge of the truth, that they with us and we with them may be saved.

**C.3 Civil authority**

**Bid (German).** Zum andern bittet für das Weltlich Regiment: Erstlich für das Haupt, die Römische Kayserliche Majestat, unsern aller gnedigsten Herren, Darnach für die Glieder, alß Churfürsten, Fürsten und Herren der gantzen Christenheit, In sonderheit aber für unsere gnedige Herren, Frawe und Frewlein von Hanaw, für irer Gnaden Räthe, Amptleut, Diener und die gantze Herrschafft, für ein ersam Gericht und Gemeine alhie, auch die umbligende Nachpaurschafft. Der Allmechtige Gott verleihe der Oberkeit seinen Heiligen Geist und weißheit, das sie Christlich und wol regieren, die Unterthanen in gemeinem friden erhalten und bewaren.

**Bid (English).** Secondly, pray ye for the temporal government: first for the head, his Roman Imperial Majesty, our most gracious lord; then for the members, as the Electors, princes and lords of all Christendom; but especially for our gracious lords, lady and damsels of Hanau, for their Graces' counsellors, officers, servants and the whole lordship, for a worshipful court and commune here, and also the neighbourhood round about. Almighty God vouchsafe unto the magistrates his Holy Spirit and wisdom, that they may rule in Christian wise and well, and keep and preserve the subjects in common peace.

**C.4 All estates / households**

**Bid (German).** Letzlich bittet auch für den Ehelichen stand, der Allmechtige Gott verleihe allen Eheleuten seinen Heiligen Geist, das sie Christlich, fridlich und eintrechtiglich beieinander leben, ihre Kinder und Gesind zu Gottes forcht, auch ehr und tugent mögen aufferziehen.

**Bid (English).** Lastly, pray ye also for the estate of matrimony: Almighty God vouchsafe unto all married folk his Holy Spirit, that they may live together in Christian wise, peaceably and in concord, and may bring up their children and household in the fear of God, and also in honour and virtue.

**C.5 Fruits of the earth**

**Bid (German).** Bittet für die frucht des Feldes, umb ein seliges Wetter und umb alles, so uns von nöten ist.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye for the fruit of the field, for seasonable weather, and for all that is needful unto us.

**C.6 The afflicted**

**Bid (German).** Kinder und Krancken wölle unser Herrgott pflegen und warten, Schwangern und Seugerin fröliche frucht und gedeien geben, die gefangnen loß und ledig machen.

**Bid (English).** May our Lord God tend and keep children and the sick, give unto women with child and them that give suck joyful fruit and increase, and loose and set free the captives.

**C.7 Special intercessions**

**Bid (German).** Und ein jeglicher bedenck sein eigene not und kom mit ir für Gott, den himlischen Vater, und zweiffel nicht, er werde uns gnediglich durch Christum erhören. Und sprecht von gantzem hertzen also:

**Bid (English).** And let every man consider his own need and come with it before God, the heavenly Father, and doubt not that he will graciously hear us through Christ. And say with your whole heart thus:

**C.8 Lord's Prayer**

**Prayer (German).** Unser Vater, der du bist im Himel, Geheiliget werde dein Nam. Zukom dein Reich. Dein will geschehe auff Erden wie im Himel. Unser täglich Brot gib uns heut. Und vergib uns unser Schuld, alß wir vergeben unseren Schuldigern. Füre uns nit in versuchung, Sondern erlöse uns von dem bösen. Dann dein ist das Reich und die Krafft und die Herrligkeit von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father, which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, from everlasting to everlasting. Amen.

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### 6.8 Family D: Nürnberg-type Vermahnung zum Gebet

"Vermahnung zum Gebet": an exhortation in the second person ("Lieben Freund, bittet …") listing the intentions, closed by the Our Father. Copied in Waldeck, Erbach, Solms-Laubach and Henneberg.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Nürnberg 1545 (Veit Dietrich).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Nürnberg 1545):** In the “Ordnung der messen auf dem land, wo nicht schulen sind”: after the opening German psalm the pastor reads, in place of the Epistle, this exhortation with the Our Father, followed by the Creed, the Ten Commandments and the catechism pieces on Baptism, the Keys and the Supper (the medieval pulpit office, Prone).

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1545 | Nürnberg, Agendbüchlein für die Pfarrherren auf dem Land (Veit Dietrich) | Nürnberg (Imperial city) and its rural parishes | Sehling 11, V.1, pp. 500–501 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1556 | Waldeck, Kirchenordnung (Kirchen Ordnung auff den Dörffern) | County of Waldeck | Sehling 9, II/Waldeck Nr. 15 (Kirchenordnung 1556), pp. 273–274 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1560 | Erbach, Kirchenordnung (Graf Georg) | County of Erbach | Sehling 9, IV/Erbach Nr. 6 (2. Erbacher Kirchenordnung 1560), pp. 428–429 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1576 | Solms-Laubach, Kirchenordnung [1576–1580] | County of Solms-Laubach | Sehling 9, III/Solms Nr. 10, pp. 360–361 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1582 | Henneberg, Kirchenordnung (Graf Georg Ernst) | County of Henneberg | Sehling 2, Henneberg Nr. 3, p. 308 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |

The family has two lines, and the representative text joins them. Veit Dietrich's exhortation (Nürnberg 1545, copied in Waldeck 1556) supplies D.3, D.7, D.12 and D.14. The Erbach line (Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576, Henneberg 1582) supplies most of the rest, and it has the majority for the magistrates (D.6). So the text has two openings: D.3 (Nürnberg) and D.4 (Erbach). To read Veit Dietrich's prayer alone, use the Prayers sheet of the workbook, or the critical sheets.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Nürnberg 1545 no. 2 (Civil authority); Waldeck 1556 no. 2 (Civil authority); Erbach 1560 no. 7 (All estates / households); Erbach 1560 no. 8 (Lord's Prayer); Solms-Laubach 1576 no. 5 (All estates / households); Solms-Laubach 1576 no. 7 (Special intercessions); Henneberg 1582 no. 5 (All estates / households); Henneberg 1582 no. 9 (Special intercessions).

**Sequence:** D.1 Exhortation / preface > D.2 Thanksgiving > D.3 The Word & its fruit > D.4 The Church > D.5 Peace > D.6 Civil authority > D.7 All estates / households > D.8 The persecuted > D.9 The afflicted > D.10 The erring & unbelievers > D.11 Women with child > D.12 Lord's Prayer > D.13 Special intercessions > D.14 Creed > D.15 Blessing.

**D.1 Exhortation / preface**

*Witnesses:* Henneberg 1582.

**Rubric (German).** Nach der predigt sol der kirchendiener das volk zum gebet, fur alle stende und not der christlichen kirchen vermittelst nachfolgender form mit vleis abermals ermanen. ¶ Forma des gemeinen gebets.

**Rubric (English).** After the sermon the minister shall again diligently exhort the people to prayer for all estates and the need of the Christian Church by means of the following form. ¶ Form of the common prayer.

**Bid (German).** Geliebten im herrn Christo, weil wir im namen unsers herren Christi jetzt alhie versamlet sind, göttlichen befehl und gebot haben, wir sollen beten, darzu verheissung, was wir im namen Jesu Christi bitten, das es unser gnediger vater im himel uns gern geben wolle.

**Bid (English).** Beloved in the Lord Christ, forasmuch as we are now here gathered together in the name of our Lord Christ, and have God’s commandment and bidding that we should pray, and moreover the promise that whatsoever we ask in the name of Jesus Christ, our gracious Father in heaven will gladly give it us:

**D.2 Thanksgiving**

*Witnesses:* Solms-Laubach 1576.

**Rubric (German).** Zu ende der predigt sollen die verhandlete stuck kurtzlich repetirt und alßdan, wo personen, so sich miteinander ehelich versprochen, angeben, proclamirt werden, daruf dancksagung und gebett volgen, also: ¶ Dancksagung und gemein gebett

**Rubric (English).** At the end of the sermon the matters handled shall be briefly repeated, and then, if there be persons that have given in their names as betrothed one to another, they shall be proclaimed; whereupon thanksgiving and prayer shall follow, thus: ¶ Thanksgiving and common prayer

**Bid (German).** Dieweil wir nun Gottes wortt haben angehort und schuldig seint, Gott dem allmechtigen fur alle seine wollthatt, so er uns täglich erzeigt, zudancken, so wollen wir ime dancksagen vor das werck der erschöpfung, erlösung und heiligung, das er auch noch fur und fur biß an den jungsten tag in seiner erkantnus uns erhelt, zum geistlichen, weltlichen und haußstandt seine gnad verleyhet und uns segenet, seint auch schuldig, umb erhaltung derselben stende und was darzu gehörig, zubitten, haben göttliche verheissung und gewisse zusage, was wir im nhamen Jhesu Christi bitten werden, das unß dasselbige der vatter im hiemel geben wölle.

**Bid (English).** Forasmuch now as we have heard God’s word, and are bound to give thanks unto God Almighty for all his benefits which he daily showeth us, we will give him thanks for the work of creation, redemption and sanctification; that he still keepeth us evermore in his knowledge until the last day, and vouchsafeth his grace to the spiritual, temporal and household estate, and blesseth us. We are bound also to pray for the preservation of the same estates and what pertaineth thereto; and we have God’s promise and sure assurance that whatsoever we shall ask in the name of Jesus Christ, the Father in heaven will give it us.

**D.3 The Word & its fruit**

*Witnesses:* Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556.

**Rubric (German).** Vermanung zu bitten für allerlei stende:

**Rubric (English).** Exhortation to pray for all manner of estates:

**Bid (German).** Ir auserwelten, bittet Gott, den Vater aller barmherzigkeit, durch Jesum Christum, unsern lieben Herren, umb fruchtbar gedeien des heiligen evangelions, das er rechtgeschaffne arbeiter in seine ernte senden wölle, auch bede - diener und

hörer des worts - gnediglich erleuchten zur heiligung seines gebenedeiten namens, merung seines reichs und erfüllung seines göttlichen willens.

**Bid (English).** Ye elect, pray God the Father of all mercy, through Jesus Christ our dear Lord, for the fruitful increase of the holy Gospel, that he would send right and true labourers into his harvest, and graciously enlighten both ministers and hearers of the word, to the hallowing of his blessed name, the increase of his kingdom and the fulfilling of his divine will.

**D.4 The Church**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** So last uns erstlich bedencken die noth der gantzen Christenheit und bitten, daß Gott uns sein wort rein und lauter erhalten, auch die jenigen, so noch nit zu rechter erkentniß kommen, herzu führen und seine arme Christenheit gnediglich behüten wölle wider alles fürnehmen des Teuffels.

**Bid (English).** Let us therefore first consider the need of all Christendom, and pray that God would keep his word pure and clear unto us, and also bring thereto them that are not yet come to the right knowledge, and graciously guard his poor Christendom against all the devices of the devil.

**D.5 Peace**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** Darnach last uns auch bitten für dieses zeitlich leben, daß uns Gott mit gnedigem fride und seligem Wetter begnaden, vor Theurung, Kriege unnd Pestilentz behüten wölle.

**Bid (English).** Thereafter let us also pray for this temporal life, that God would bless us with gracious peace and seasonable weather, and keep us from dearth, war and pestilence.

**D.6 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** Bittet auch für alle Oberkeit, Keyser, König, Fürsten und Herrn, In sonderheit für unsere gnedige Herrschafft allhier, daß Gott ire hertzen durch seinen Geist und wort erleuchten wölle, Auff das Gottes wort und ehre durch sie gefordert unnd nicht verhindert werde, auch wir dester mehr fridens bey ihrem Regiment haben mögen.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for all magistrates, Emperor, kings, princes and lords, especially for our gracious lordship here, that God would enlighten their hearts by his Spirit and word, that God’s word and honour may be furthered and not hindered by them, and that we also may have the more peace under their government.

**D.7 All estates / households**

*Witnesses:* Nürnberg 1545 and Waldeck 1556.

**Bid (German).** Ferner bittet für alle eheleute, hausherrn und frauen, arbeiter, handierer, eehalten, sünder und sünderin, kranke, gefangene, betrübte, verlaßne witwen und waisen und die, so in anfechtung stecken, betrübte, irrige, verfürte gewissen oder was dergleichen sein. Der ewig gütig Gott wölle sich aller erbarmen, ire missetat verzeihen, ehrlichen, fridlichen, erbarn wandel nach seinem wort verleihen und in keiner versuchung sinken lassen, sonder von allem ubel, es sei leiblich oder geistlich, durch reine leer und festen glauben gnediglich erlösen. Amen.

**Bid (English).** Further, pray ye for all married folk, masters and mistresses of households, labourers, tradesmen, servants, sinners men and women, the sick, the captives, the sorrowful, forsaken widows and orphans, and them that are in temptation, sorrowful, erring and misled consciences, or whatsoever else there be of the like. The eternal, gracious God have mercy upon all, pardon their misdeeds, vouchsafe them an honourable, peaceable, honest conversation according to his word, and let them sink in no temptation, but graciously deliver them from all evil, be it bodily or ghostly, through pure doctrine and firm faith. Amen.

**D.8 The persecuted**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560 and Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** Dieweil auch hin und wider inn allen landen viel armer Christen umb deß wort Gottes und der gerechtigkeit willen verfolgt, verjagt, gefencklich eingezogen, elendiglichen gemartert und erwürgt werden, sind wir schuldig, für sie Gott zubitten, das er durch seinen heiligen Geist ire hertzen trösten und stercken, im bekentniß sie fest erhalten und seliglichen ihnen helffen wölle an leib und sehle.

**Bid (English).** Forasmuch also as here and there in all lands many poor Christians are for the word of God and for righteousness' sake persecuted, driven out, cast into prison, miserably tormented and slain, we are bound to pray God for them, that he would comfort and strengthen their hearts by his Holy Spirit, keep them steadfast in the confession, and help them blessedly in body and soul.

**D.9 The afflicted**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** Darnach last uns auch bitten für unsere arme Brüder und schwestern, hie unnd inn der gantzen Welt, da entweder schwere kranckheit odder grosse anfechtung sind, das sie Gott mit gnaden erledigen wölle.

**Bid (English).** Thereafter let us also pray for our poor brethren and sisters, here and in the whole world, where there is either grievous sickness or great temptation, that God would graciously deliver them.

**D.10 The erring & unbelievers**

*Witnesses:* Henneberg 1582.

**Bid (German).** Letztlich bittet auch fur die arme leute, so noch unter dem babstumb in irrtumb und bösem gewissen ligen und die selige erkentnis des worts nicht haben, wie wir, das sie gott zu solchem licht seiner gnaden auch füren und sie mit uns durch rechten glauben an Christum wolle ewig selig machen.

**Bid (English).** Lastly pray ye also for the poor people that yet lie under the papacy in error and an evil conscience, and have not the blessed knowledge of the word as we have, that God would lead them also to such light of his grace and make them with us eternally blessed through right faith in Christ.

**D.11 Women with child**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560.

**Bid (German).** Bittet auch für alle schwangere frawen, das sie von kinds banden gnediglich erlöst werden, für diese unnd alle andere nodturfft der gantzen Christenheit, auch für unsere feinde, das sie möchten bekert unnd zu rechter erkäntniß unsers Herrn Jhesu Christi gebracht werden.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for all women with child, that they may be graciously delivered from the bonds of childbirth; for these and all other necessities of the whole of Christendom; and also for our enemies, that they may be converted and brought to the right knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.

**D.12 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Nürnberg 1545, Waldeck 1556, Solms-Laubach 1576 and Henneberg 1582. *Solms-Laubach 1576 lacks the bid. The prayer is in Nürnberg 1545 and Solms-Laubach 1576 only.*

**Bid (German).** Solches alles zu erwerben, sprecht aus rechtem glauben:

**Bid (English).** To obtain all this, say out of right faith:

**Prayer (German).** Vater unser..., sonder erlöse uns von ubel; dann dein ist das reich, die kraft und die herrligkeit in ewigkeit. Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father ..., but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

**D.13 Special intercessions**

*Witnesses:* Erbach 1560.

**Rubric (German).** So mögen auch jeder zeit aus zufallender not, als in kriegen, sterben unnd thewrung, sonderliche gebet, so darzu dienlich, dieselbige zeit hinzu gethan unnd gebraucht werden.

**Rubric (English).** So also at any time, by reason of need befalling, as in wars, pestilence and dearth, special prayers serving thereto may for that time be added and used.

**D.14 Creed**

*Witnesses:* Nürnberg 1545.

**Rubric (German).** Die artikel unsers glaubens.

**Rubric (English).** The articles of our faith.

**Prayer (German).** Ich glaub in Gott, Vater almechtigen, schöpfer himels und der erden, …

**Prayer (English).** I believe in God the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, …

**D.15 Blessing**

*Witnesses:* Henneberg 1582.

**Rubric (German).** Nach solcher vermanung und dem gesprochenen vater unser, sol der prediger nachfolgenden segen uber das volk sprechen:

**Rubric (English).** After such exhortation and the Our Father said, the preacher shall speak the following blessing over the people:

**Prayer (German).** Die gnade unsers herren Jesu Christi, die liebe gottes und die gemeinschaft des heiligen geistes sei mit euch allen, amen.

**Prayer (English).** The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost be with you all. Amen.

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## 6.9 Family E: Saxon Gemein Gebet (Melanchthon/Pfeffinger)

The Albertine Saxon "Gemein Gebet" in the Melanchthon/Pfeffinger tradition, a continuous prayer with pronounced petitions against war and for the Elector.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Leipzig 1567.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer.
- **Place in the service (Leipzig 1567):** After the sermon, “mit mund und herzen zu sprechen”.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1567 | Leipzig, Gemein gebet (renewed by Johann Pfeffinger) | Leipzig (Electoral Saxony) | Sehling 1, IV. Theil, Nr. 108, pp. 595–596 | continuous prayer |

**Sequence:** E.1 Repentance & forgiveness > E.2 The Church > E.3 Civil authority > E.4 Peace > E.5 Civil authority > E.6 The afflicted.

**E.1 Repentance & forgiveness**

**Rubric (German).** Gemein gebet. Nach der predigt mit mund und herzen zu sprechen.

**Rubric (English).** Common prayer. To be said after the sermon with mouth and heart.

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger got und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, wir bekennen, das wir mit vielen sünden, wissentlich und unwissentlich vorunreinet sind, und ist uns herzlich leid, das wir wider deinen gerechten willen gethan haben, und bitten, du wollest unsere herzen zu dir bekeren, und uns alle unsere sünde, umb deines lieben sohns Jesu Christi willen vorgeben, und wollest in uns mit deinem heiligen geist rechten glauben und rechten gehorsam anzünden, und uns regieren. So ist auch unser ernstlicher fürsatz, uns mit deiner hülf zu bessern, und in deinem gehorsam zu leben.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, we confess that we are defiled with many sins, wittingly and unwittingly, and it grieveth us heartily that we have done against thy righteous will; and we beseech thee that thou wouldest turn our hearts unto thee, and forgive us all our sins for thy dear Son Jesus Christ's sake, and kindle in us by thy Holy Spirit right faith and right obedience, and govern us. So is it also our earnest purpose to amend ourselves with thy help and to live in thy obedience.

**E.2 The Church**

**Prayer (German).** Wir bitten auch, umb deins lieben sohns, Jesu Christi willen, du wollest unter uns in diesen landen für und für eine kirche samlen, und christlich reine lehre erhalten, treue lehrer und prediger geben, die mit rechter lehr und gutem exempel, zu deinem lob und der leute seligkeit dienen.

**Prayer (English).** We beseech thee also, for thy dear Son Jesus Christ's sake, that thou wouldest evermore gather a Church among us in these lands, and preserve Christian pure doctrine, and give faithful teachers and preachers, which with right doctrine and good example may serve to thy praise and the salvation of the people.

**E.3 Civil authority**

**Prayer (German).** Und bitten von herzen, du wollest umb deines lieben sohns Jesu Christi willen, disen landen fridlich christlich selig regiment geben, und römische keiserliche majestät und unsern herrschaften herzog regenten churfursten und seiner churfürstlichen gnaden zugethane und verwante, mit dem heiligen geist regieren, das ir leben und regierung, dir zu lobe, und inen und den unterthanen zu frieden und seligkeit dienen möge.

**Prayer (English).** And we beseech thee from our heart that thou wouldest, for thy dear Son Jesus Christ's sake, give unto these lands peaceable, Christian, blessed government, and govern with the Holy Spirit the Roman Imperial Majesty and our lordships, the duke regent Elector and his Electoral Grace's adherents and kinsfolk, that their life and government may serve to thy praise, and to peace and salvation for them and for the subjects.

**E.4 Peace**

**Prayer (German).** Wollest auch ire churfürstlichen gnaden sampt derselbigen zugethanen und angehörigen, in diesen beschwerlichen und sonstigen kriges hendeln, durch deine grundlose barmherzigkeit, behüten, schützen und bewaren. Die widerwertigen, unruigen und ungehorsamen, so göttlicher ordnung widerstreben, die herrschaft vorachten, den frieden brechen, und zu blutvergiessen, leut und land vorderbung ursach geben, gnediglich bekeren, oder ihnen steuren und wehren, und den befolnen rechtmessigen kriege, mit seliger wolfart zu gutem, glücklichem, friedlichem ende bringen, auf das vieler christen unschuldiges blutvergiessen, vorwüstung dieser landen, schulen und kirchen, abgewendet und vorhutet werden.

**Prayer (English).** Wilt thou also by thy bottomless mercy guard, protect and preserve his Electoral Grace, together with his adherents and kinsmen, in these grievous and other matters of war; graciously convert the adversaries, the unquiet and disobedient, which resist the divine ordinance, despise authority, break the peace, and give occasion to bloodshed and the ruin of people and land, or else restrain and withstand them; and bring the lawful war committed unto us to a good, happy, peaceable end with blessed welfare, that the innocent bloodshed of many Christians and the wasting of these lands, schools and churches may be turned away and prevented.

**E.5 Civil authority**

**Prayer (German).** Und wollest auch dieser stadt obrigkeit und unterthanen gnediglich regieren und bewahren, und die früchte der erden (die du giebst, das in diesem leiblichen leben die menschen erhalten werden, um dich lernen erkennen und anrufen) und das tegliche brot williglich geben und segnen.

**Prayer (English).** And wilt thou also graciously govern and preserve the magistrates and subjects of this city, and willingly give and bless the fruits of the earth (which thou givest that men may be preserved in this bodily life, to learn to know thee and call upon thee) and our daily bread.

**E.6 The afflicted**

**Prayer (German).** Du weist auch die grosse schwachheit menschlicher natur, und wilt darumb deinen grossen zorn mit barmherzigkeit lindern, von wegen des vordiensts und fürbits deines allerliebsten sohns Jesu Christi unsers herren willen. Darumb bitten wir dich, du wollest unser wolverdienten strafen gnediglich lindern, und alle betrübten, die dich anrufen, mit deinem heiligen geist trösten, das sie in rechtem glauben und rechter anrufung bleiben, und deine barmherzigkeit in ewigkeit preisen. Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Thou knowest also the great weakness of man's nature, and wilt therefore temper thy great wrath with mercy, for the sake of the merit and intercession of thy most dear Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Therefore we beseech thee that thou wouldest graciously temper our well-deserved punishments, and comfort with thy Holy Spirit all the sorrowful that call upon thee, that they may abide in right faith and right calling upon thee, and praise thy mercy for ever. Amen.

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## 6.10 Family F: Upper German pulpit intercession (Strasbourg/Zürich)

Upper German (Bucerian/Zwinglian) intercession after the sermon, a continuous prayer with rubrics, related to Zürich 1535 and the Strasbourg forms.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Augsburg 1537.
- **Tradition:** Moderate Reformed (Upper German, Bucerian).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer with rubrics + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Augsburg 1537):** At the end of the sermon service (after the Decalogue, confession, and the Creed); banns and requests for prayer are read within it.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1537 | Augsburg, Kirchenordnung (Die zehen gebot, Articul des Glaubens, Und das Vater unser) (Moderate Reformed) | Augsburg (Imperial city) | Sehling 12, I.8a, pp. 70–71 | prayer with rubrics + Lord's Prayer |

**Sequence:** F.1 Exhortation / preface > F.2 All men > F.3 Civil authority > F.4 Ministers of the Word > F.5 All estates / households > F.6 Special intercessions > F.7 Women with child > F.8 Schools & youth > F.9 All estates / households > F.10 The afflicted > F.11 Special intercessions > F.12 The persecuted > F.13 The erring & unbelievers > F.14 Against the Turk > F.15 Against the Turk > F.16 Lord's Prayer.

**F.1 Exhortation / preface**

**Rubric (German).** Fürbitt für die gemeinen stend:

**Rubric (English).** Intercession for the common estates:

**Bid (German).** Dieweil es aber vor Gott unserm hailand gut und angenäm ist, und er uns durch seinen hailigen apostel bevolhen hat, für alle menschen zu bitten, so lassend uns in seinem namen, in dem uns alles guts verhaißen ist, mit warem glauben und herzlichem vertrauen für Gott unsern gütigen Vater treten und also sprechen:

**Bid (English).** But forasmuch as it is good and acceptable before God our Saviour, and he hath commanded us by his holy Apostle to pray for all men, let us in his name, wherein all good is promised us, come before God our gracious Father with true faith and hearty confidence, and say thus:

**F.2 All men**

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger ewiger Gott, lieber getreuer Vater im himel, wie sich dein große gnad und gütigkeit reichlich erzaigt gegen allen menschen, also, dieweil wir deine kinder seind, begeren wir uns von herzen, deiner väterlichen miltigait sovil müglich nach zuarten und unser liebe an allen menschen mit unserm getreuen fürbitt, so wir nit weiter können, christelich zu beweisen, und rufen dich also an durch deinen Sun Jesum Christum, unsern lieben Herren und Hailand, für alle stend und anligen deiner hailgen christenhait.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty, everlasting God, dear and faithful Father in heaven: as thy great grace and goodness showeth itself richly toward all men, so, forasmuch as we are thy children, we desire from our hearts to take after thy fatherly bounty as far as may be, and to show forth our love toward all men in Christian wise by our faithful intercession, since we can do no more; and we call upon thee therefore, through thy Son Jesus Christ, our dear Lord and Saviour, for all the estates and concerns of thy holy Christendom.

**F.3 Civil authority**

**Prayer (German).** Erstlich für unsern herr kaiser, künig, all fürsten herren und regenten, sonderlich aber für unser ersame oberkait in diser statt. Verleich inen allen den gaist deiner forcht und weisheit, das si all ir regiment zu lob und preis deines großen namens und fridlicher erhaltung der undertan zu aller erbarkait und gotseligkait anrichtend. Den undertanen aber gib ain willigs, glimpfigs herz, der oberkait in allem, das nit wider dich ist, zu gehorsamen.

**Prayer (English).** First for our lord the Emperor, the King, all princes, lords and rulers, but especially for our worshipful magistrates in this city. Vouchsafe unto them all the spirit of thy fear and wisdom, that they may order all their government to the praise and glory of thy great name and to the peaceable preservation of the subjects in all honesty and godliness. But unto the subjects give a willing and seemly heart to obey the magistrates in all that is not against thee.

**F.4 Ministers of the Word**

**Prayer (German).** Auch bitten wir dich von herzen, verleich allen dienern und verkündigern deines hailgen worts, das si mit gesunder lere und unsträflichem leben deiner hailgen gmaind zu täglicher besserung christelich vorstandend. Sonderlich aber, getreuer Vater, wöllest alle gute mittel jederzeit gnädiglich fügen, damit weder uns noch unsern nachkomen an getreuen ausspendern deiner gehaimnus und des trostlichen evangelii von deinem Sun Jesu Christo nimmer mehr mangle!

**Prayer (English).** We beseech thee also from our hearts, grant unto all ministers and preachers of thy holy word that with sound doctrine and unblameable life they may preside in Christian wise over thy holy congregation to its daily amendment. But especially, faithful Father, ordain graciously at all times all good means, that neither we nor our posterity may ever lack faithful stewards of thy mysteries and of the comfortable Gospel of thy Son Jesus Christ.

**F.5 All estates / households**

**Prayer (German).** Erbarm dich auch, gnediger Gott, über alle hausväter und hausmütern, auch schulmaister und alle die, so kind oder gesind haben, das si dieselbigen gotseliglich nach anweisung deines worts zu deinem preis und nutz deiner kirchen erziehen und regieren! Laß auch lieber Got, deinen frid und segen reichlich walten über all ehleut, damit si in lieb und ainigkait bei ainander wonen und all ehlich beschwerden mit glauben und gedult tragen mögen! Sonderlich aber verleich solchs disen personen, die sich begeren, ehlich mitainander zu verpflichten, mit namen etc.

**Prayer (English).** Have mercy also, gracious God, upon all fathers and mothers of households, and also schoolmasters and all that have children or servants, that they may bring them up and govern them godly according to the direction of thy word, to thy praise and the profit of thy Church. Let also, dear God, thy peace and blessing prevail richly over all married folk, that they may dwell together in love and unity and bear all the burdens of wedlock with faith and patience. But especially vouchsafe this unto these persons that desire to bind themselves together in marriage, by name, etc.

**F.6 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (German).** Hie sollen die hochzeiten verkünd werden und dann darauf weiter also gesprochen:

**Rubric (English).** Here the marriages shall be published, and then thereupon further said thus:

**Prayer (German).** Verleich in, barmherziger Vater, disen hailgen stand in deiner forcht anzetreten, das si auch christelich darin leben und denselbigen seliglich beschließen mögen!

**Prayer (English).** Grant them, merciful Father, to enter upon this holy estate in thy fear, that they may also live therein in Christian wise and close the same blessedly.

**F.7 Women with child**

**Prayer (German).** Wöllest auch, o himlischer Vater, die geperenden frauen mit gnaden empinden und si mit ainer wolgetonen und dir gefelligen frucht gnediglich erfröuen!

**Prayer (English).** Wilt thou also, O heavenly Father, graciously deliver women in travail and gladden them graciously with a well-formed fruit, well-pleasing unto thee.

**F.8 Schools & youth**

**Prayer (German).** Auch bitten wir dich, gütiger Vater, für unser unerzogne jugent, das du si durch deinen Hailigen Gaist väterlich aufziehen und nach deinem willen und wolgefallen bilden wöllest, damit si in deiner forcht und glauben an deinen Sun Jesum Christum seliglich aufwachsen und aller dienst deiner gemaind für und für durch si wol und christelich möge ersetzt werden.

**Prayer (English).** We pray thee also, gracious Father, for our youth not yet brought up, that thou wouldest bring them up in fatherly wise by thy Holy Spirit and form them according to thy will and good pleasure, that they may grow up blessedly in thy fear and in faith in thy Son Jesus Christ, and that every service of thy congregation may evermore be well and christianly supplied by them.

**F.9 All estates / households**

**Prayer (German).** Gib dein gnedigs gedeihen und benedeiung allen getreuen eehalten und arbaitern! Die armen begab mit leibsnarung und christlicher glassenhait, die reichen mit gläubiger miltigkait!

**Prayer (English).** Give thy gracious increase and blessing to all faithful servants and labourers. Endow the poor with bodily sustenance and Christian resignation, the rich with faithful liberality.

**F.10 The afflicted**

**Prayer (German).** Erzaig dich ain getreuen milten Vater allen betrübten, angefochtnen herzen von innen oder außen! Den kranken verleich langmütig gedultigkait, den sterbenden ain fröliche himelfart! Und in sonderhait erbarm dich etlicher die unsers fürbitts diser zeit in irem leiden, krankhait und trübsal begeren!

**Prayer (English).** Show thyself a faithful and bountiful Father to all sorrowful hearts, tempted within or without. Grant unto the sick long-suffering patience, to the dying a joyful going up to heaven. And in especial have mercy upon certain which at this time in their suffering, sickness and tribulation desire our intercession.

**F.11 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (German).** Hie soll er die verkündigen, so des gemainen bets begeren, und darauf dann sprechen:

**Rubric (English).** Here he shall announce them that desire the common prayer, and thereupon say:

**Prayer (German).** Laß inen, treuer Gott, alles das väterlich widerfaren, das si nach deinem wilen durch unser fürbitt von dir begeren zu erlangen! Gib inen den trost deiner gnaden, das si mitten im leiden und trübsal dein väterlich herz in warem glauben empfinden und in der gedult vil frucht bringen mögen! Sterk alle klainmütige und schwachgläubige!

**Prayer (English).** Let all that befall them in fatherly wise, faithful God, which according to thy will they desire to obtain of thee through our intercession. Give them the comfort of thy grace, that in the midst of suffering and tribulation they may feel thy fatherly heart in true faith and bring forth much fruit in patience. Strengthen all the fainthearted and weak in faith.

**F.12 The persecuted**

**Prayer (German).** Erhalt mit deiner gewaltigen hand alle, die umb deines names und der gerechtigkait willen under dem grausamen Türken oder sunst gefengnus und verfolgung leiden!

**Prayer (English).** Uphold with thy mighty hand all that for thy name's and for righteousness' sake suffer imprisonment and persecution under the cruel Turk or otherwise.

**F.13 The erring & unbelievers**

**Prayer (German).** Weis und lait alle irrige den weg christlicher warhait und des ewigen lebens! Erleucht alle verblende! Erwaich alle verherdte! Widerbring alle abgefalne von christlichen glauben und ainigkait deiner kirchen! Treib aus den unglauben aus aller menschen herzen, damit dein reich täglich je mehr und mehr zukomme und dein aingeborner Sun, unser lieber Herr und Hailand Jesus Christus, der ganzen welt bekant, von ir gelobt und geprisen werde.

**Prayer (English).** Show and lead all that err into the way of Christian truth and of eternal life. Enlighten all the blinded. Soften all the hardened. Bring back all that are fallen away from the Christian faith and the unity of thy Church. Drive out unbelief from the hearts of all men, that thy kingdom may daily come more and more, and thine only-begotten Son, our dear Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ, be known to the whole world and be lauded and praised of it.

**F.14 Against the Turk**

**Rubric (German).** Wider den türken und die verfolger des evangelions

**Rubric (English).** Against the Turk and the persecutors of the Gospel

**Bid (German).** Schliest auch darneben ein den greulichen erbfeind des christlichen namens, den Türken! Bitten, das in der almechtig Got mit dem atem seines Hailigen Gaists wöll schlahen, damit das der nam Jesu Christi nit durch in gelestert und nit sovil christlichs blut durch in vergossen werd! Für dise und alle andre not der ganzen christenhait, auch für uns selbs und für alle die, für welche wir schuldig seind zu bitten, wöllen wir mit herzlicher demütigkait nit allain mit dem mund, sonder von ganzem herzen zu Gott bitten und also sprechen: Unser vater etc.

**Bid (English).** Include also therewith the horrible hereditary enemy of the Christian name, the Turk; praying that almighty God would smite him with the breath of his Holy Spirit, that the name of Jesus Christ be not blasphemed by him, nor so much Christian blood shed by him. For this and all other need of the whole of Christendom, and also for ourselves and for all for whom we are bound to pray, we will pray to God with hearty humility, not with the mouth only but with the whole heart, and say thus: Our Father, etc.

**F.15 Against the Turk**

**Rubric (German).** Oder also:

**Rubric (English).** Or thus:

**Prayer (German).** Du wöllest auch, o getreuer Gott und Vater, dem gewalt des tyrannischen, widerchristischen reichs des Türken, so wider Christum frävenlich setzt, sampt aller abgötterei, tyrannei und gotlosem wesen mit deiner almechtigen kraft weeren und zum schämel der füß Christi stürzen, damit nit dein götlicher nam sampt dem glauben Christi in uns von dem unglaubigen volk und feinden der warheit verspottet und geschmächt, sonder durch deinen Hailigen Gaist erweitert und ausgebrait und der feind durch Christum Jesum abgetriben werde.

**Prayer (English).** Wilt thou also, O faithful God and Father, with thine almighty power withstand the might of the tyrannous, antichristian kingdom of the Turk, which setteth itself wantonly against Christ, together with all idolatry, tyranny and ungodly being, and cast it down to be the footstool of Christ's feet; that thy divine name, together with the faith of Christ in us, be not mocked and reviled by the unbelieving people and the enemies of the truth, but be enlarged and spread abroad by thy Holy Spirit, and the enemy be driven back through Christ Jesus.

**F.16 Lord's Prayer**

**Rubric (German).** Volget das Vater unser:

**Rubric (English).** The Our Father followeth:

**Bid (German).** In desselbigen namen, o treuer, gütiger und barmherziger Vater, und aus seinem gehaiß komen wir für dein angesicht und rufen dich an, wie uns unser Herr Jesus Christus selbs geleert und zu beten bevolhen hat, und sprechend:

**Bid (English).** In his name, O faithful, gracious and merciful Father, and at his bidding, we come before thy face and call upon thee, as our Lord Jesus Christ himself hath taught and commanded us to pray, and say:

**Prayer (German).** Unser Vater, der du bist in den himlen. Gehailiget werd dein nam! Zukumme dein reich! Dein will geschech auf erden wie im himel! Unser täglich brot gib uns heut und vergib uns unsere schuld, als und wir vergeben unsern schuldigern, und für uns nit in versuchung, sonder erlös uns von dem bösen! Dann dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herrlichait in ewigkait. Amen.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father, which art in the heavens. Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.

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## 6.11 Family G: Hessian Vermanung zum Gebet

Hessian "Vermanung zum Gebet": a numbered bidding exhortation which the order allows to be shortened or lengthened locally.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Hessen 1566.
- **Tradition:** Moderate Reformed (Philip of Hesse's church).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** numbered bidding exhortation.
- **Place in the service (Hessen 1566):** The fifth part of the service: after the Creed and the sermon, “das gebet vor allerlei stende und allerlei anligende not der kirchen”, justified from Justin Martyr (Apol. I 65) and Tertullian (Apol. 30–39).

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1566 | Hessen, Kirchenordnung 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | Landgraviate of Hesse | Sehling 8, I/Hessen Nr. 17 (KO 1566), pp. 245–246 | bidding exhortation (numbered) |

**Sequence:** G.1 Exhortation / preface > G.2 Ministers of the Word > G.3 Civil authority > G.4 The erring & unbelievers > G.5 Enemies > G.6 The afflicted > G.7 Deliverance from calamities > G.8 Conclusion > G.9 Special intercessions.

**G.1 Exhortation / preface**

**Rubric (German).** Es mag aber der diener des worts die ganze kirche zum gebet uf diese weise vermanen: (a. R.: Vermanung zum gebet,)

**Rubric (English).** But the minister of the word may exhort the whole church to prayer on this wise: (in the margin: Exhortation to prayer)

**Bid (German).** Ihr geliebten im Herrn, es ist kein mensch, der nit wisse und verstehe, sobald er sein eigen gewissen fragt, daß er hulf, woltat, gnade und barmherzigkeit Gottes zu allen zeiten und allenthalben bedarf, dann wir seind allesampt arme, schwache und gebrechliche menschen. Wir seind aber gelehret vom Herrn Christo, daß wir alles guts, ja was uns nütz und not ist, von unserm himlischen Vatter allein, der allezeit weiß, was wir bedürfen, mit demütigem und bußfertigem herzen aus warem glauben bitten und gewarten sollen; darzu, wenn wir bezeugen wöllen, daß bei uns ein fünklein der brüderlichen und ungefelschten liebe sei, so seind wir schuldig nach dem befelch und exempel Christi, auch vor andere zu bitten und nit allein vor die, so uns guts günnen und tun, sondern auch vor alle stende der menschen, ja auch vor unsere feinde und verfolger, darzü auch fur wasserlei not. Und wie wir zu Gott söllen unser gebet tun insgemein, werden alle gottfürchtigen von dem Geist Gottes unterrichtet. Uber das alles haben wir ein gebott von Christo, daß wir von seinem himlischen Vatter, der da ist und will erkant sein von allen menschen als ein gütiger Herr und warer almechtiger Gott und Vatter, der uns leichtlich könne und auch wölle

gnediglich geben, alles was nutz und heilsam ist, in seinem namen bestendiglich begeren sollen. Es hat uns auch unser Herr Christus verheißen, was wir den himlischen Vatter in seinem namen bitten werden, das will er uns willig und reichlich geben. Zuletzt wissen wir auch aus der verheißung Christi, daß eines iglichen gleubigen gebet, ich geschweige der ganzen gemein, im namen Christi ordentlich versamlet, soll erhöret werden umb Christi willen. Daraus volget unwidersprechlich, daß das gemein gebet ein sonderlich merkzeichen und ubung sei der christlichen kirchen und aller gleubigen, welchs dem almechtigen Gott wolgefellig und angenem sei. Derhalben auch wir in dieser unser versamlung mit einmütigem herzen im Geist und in der warheit Gott den Herren nit allein fur uns, sonder auch fur die ganze kirche und alle stende und noturft der menschen anruffen.

**Bid (English).** Dearly beloved in the Lord, there is no man but knoweth and understandeth, so soon as he asketh his own conscience, that he needeth the help, benefits, grace and mercy of God at all times and in all places; for we are all of us poor, weak and frail men. But we are taught of the Lord Christ that we should ask and look for all good, yea, whatsoever is profitable and needful for us, from our heavenly Father alone, who ever knoweth what we need, with an humble and penitent heart out of true faith. Moreover, if we will witness that there is in us a spark of brotherly and unfeigned love, we are bound by the commandment and example of Christ to pray for others also, and not only for them that wish us well and do us good, but also for all estates of men, yea, also for our enemies and persecutors, and for whatsoever need besides. And how we should make our prayer unto God in common, all the God-fearing are instructed by the Spirit of God. Over and above all this we have a commandment from Christ that we should steadfastly ask in his name of his heavenly Father, who is, and will be known of all men as a gracious Lord and true almighty God and Father, who easily can and also will graciously give us all that is profitable and wholesome. Our Lord Christ hath also promised us that whatsoever we shall ask the heavenly Father in his name, he will give it us willingly and richly. Lastly, we know also from the promise of Christ that the prayer of every believer, to say nothing of the whole congregation lawfully gathered in the name of Christ, shall be heard for Christ's sake. Whence it followeth undeniably that the common prayer is a special mark and exercise of the Christian Church and of all believers, which is well-pleasing and acceptable unto almighty God. Therefore we also in this our assembly, with one mind in the Spirit and in truth, call upon God the Lord not only for ourselves but also for the whole Church and all estates and necessities of men:

**G.2 Ministers of the Word**

**Bid (German).** Zum ersten und vor allen dingen fur alle diener Gottes worts und glückseligem lauf des evangelii, damit dasselbige in allen landen möge gepflanzet und ausgebreitet werden und also die zal der christgleubigen wachse und zuneme, wie wir des ein befelch haben von Christo und dem apostel Paulo, nemlich daß den predigern gegeben werde, das wort mit freudigem ufftuen ihres munds zu verkündigen, damit kund und offenbar werde das geheimnus des evangelii von Christo und daß sie in demselbigen freudig handeln und reden, wie sich gebürt, der gemein zur fürderung und freude des glaubens, der kirchen aber und gemein die gnade im heiligen Geiste in Christum beigeleget werde, damit sie in aller lehr und aller erkantnus, nachdem die predige von Christo in ihr kreftig werden, reich gemacht werde, also daß sie kein mangel hab an irgend einer gabe und unstrefflich und wirdig wandel dem evangelio Christi und also stehe in einem geist und in einer seel, zu kempfen im glauben des evangelii, auch sich in keinen wege erschrecken lasse von den widersachern, sondern fest halt am evangelio bis ans ende und warte der offenbarung Jesu Christi.

**Bid (English).** First and before all things for all ministers of God's word and for the happy course of the Gospel, that the same may be planted and spread abroad in all lands, and so the number of the believers in Christ may grow and increase, as we have commandment thereof from Christ and the Apostle Paul: namely, that utterance may be given unto the preachers to proclaim the word with the joyful opening of their mouth, that the mystery of the Gospel of Christ may be made known and manifest, and that they may deal and speak boldly therein, as it becometh, to the furtherance and joy of the faith of the congregation; and that unto the Church and congregation the grace in the Holy Ghost may be given in Christ, that she may be enriched in all doctrine and all knowledge, as the preaching of Christ becometh mighty in her, so that she come behind in no gift, and walk unblameably and worthily of the Gospel of Christ, and so stand fast in one spirit and in one soul, striving for the faith of the Gospel, and be in nothing terrified by the adversaries, but hold fast to the Gospel unto the end and wait for the revelation of Jesus Christ.

**G.3 Civil authority**

**Bid (German).** Zum andern wollen wir auch bitten fur keiser, könige, fürsten, obrigkeit und alle gewaltigen und ein ruig regiment und gemeinen frieden, wie uns von dem apostel Timot. 2 befohlen wird.

**Bid (English).** Secondly, we will also pray for the Emperor, kings, princes, magistrates and all in authority, and for a quiet government and common peace, as is commanded us by the Apostle in Timothy 2.

**G.4 The erring & unbelievers**

**Bid (German).** Zum dritten fur alle diejenigen, so verlangen haben zur erkentnus der warheit, sie seien gleich wer sie wöllen, auch die so in frembden landen verfolget und gemartert werden umb der warheit willen.

**Bid (English).** Thirdly, for all them that long for the knowledge of the truth, be they who they will; and also them that in foreign lands are persecuted and martyred for the truth's sake.

**G.5 Enemies**

**Bid (German).** Zum vierten wollen wir auch bitten fur alle unsere widersacher und verfolger, vornemlich aber fur diejenigen, so aus unwissenheit der warheit widerstreben und die christen unbillicherweise verfolgen, daß ihnen Gott der Herr dies gnediglich vergebe und diese schwere sünde nit zurechnen wolle und daß er solche zum erkentnus der warheit füre, damit sie auch selig werden.

**Bid (English).** Fourthly, we will also pray for all our adversaries and persecutors, but chiefly for them that out of ignorance resist the truth and persecute the Christians unjustly, that God the Lord would graciously forgive them this and not impute this grievous sin unto them, and that he would lead such to the knowledge of the truth, that they also may be saved.

**G.6 The afflicted**

**Bid (German).** Zum fünften fur alle kranken und diejenigen, so ein innerlich oder eußerlich anfechtung haben, auch fur alle, so von wegen des kreuzes, welches ihnen Gott zuschickt, betrübt sind, daß sie mögen getröstet werden, wie wir lesen in der epistel Iacobi cap. 5.

**Bid (English).** Fifthly, for all the sick and them that have an inward or outward temptation, and also for all that are sorrowful by reason of the cross which God sendeth them, that they may be comforted, as we read in the Epistle of James, chapter 5.

**G.7 Deliverance from calamities**

**Bid (German).** Zum sechsten wollen wir insonderheit auch Gott anruffen fur gegenwertige gemeine notturft. Diese bit ist nötig, wann krieg, hunger oder teurung, oder sonst andere not und unfell vorhanden sind.

**Bid (English).** Sixthly, we will also call upon God especially for the present common necessity. This petition is needful when war, hunger or dearth, or else other need and mishaps are at hand.

**G.8 Conclusion**

**Bid (German).** Zum siebenden laßt uns auch bitten fur alle dasjenige, so der ganzen christlichen gemeine angelegen ist, fur alles, darumb Gott will angeruffen sein. Wir wollen auch undereinander fur uns selber bitten, die wir alhie zusamenkomen seind. Und laßt uns erstlich einander verzeihen und darnach Gott anruffen und bitten umb gnad und vergebung der sünden.

**Bid (English).** Seventhly, let us also pray for all that concerneth the whole Christian congregation, for all for which God will be called upon. We will also pray one for another, for ourselves that are here come together. And let us first forgive one another, and thereafter call upon God and pray for grace and forgiveness of sins.

**G.9 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (German).** Diese form des gebets mag man kürzer oder lenger machen, nach einer jeglichen kirchen gelegenheit.

**Rubric (English).** This form of prayer may be made shorter or longer, according to the circumstances of each church.

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## 6.12 Family H: Bugenhagen pulpit exhortation

Bugenhagen's pulpit exhortation after the sermon in Low German: the people are led through Creed, confession, biddings for all estates and needs, and the Our Father. Hamburg copies it verbatim; Osnabrück prescribes the same contents in indirect speech.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Braunschweig 1528 (Bugenhagen).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** Low German.
- **Form:** pulpit exhortation: Creed, confession, biddings, Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Braunschweig 1528):** From the pulpit after the sermon ("Exhortatio edder vormaninge up dem predickstole na der predige"); the exhortation to communicants before the altar follows.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1528 | Braunschweig, Der erbarn stadt Brunswig christlike ordeninge (Bugenhagen) | Braunschweig (city) | Sehling 6/1, I/1, p. 443 | exhortation: Creed + confession + biddings + Lord's Prayer |
| 1529 | Hamburg, Kirchenordnung (Bugenhagen) | Hamburg (city) | Sehling 5, Hamburg mit Landgebiet, pp. 530–531 | exhortation: Creed + confession + biddings + Lord's Prayer |
| 1543 | Stift Osnabrück, Kirchenordnung (Hermann Bonnus): Ordenunge der evangelischen missen | Prince-Bishopric (Stift) and city of Osnabrück | Sehling 7/1, III/Stift Osnabrück, pp. 224–225 | prescription of contents (indirect speech) |

Osnabrück 1543 prescribes the contents in indirect speech. It supplies H.3 and H.5.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Osnabrück 1543 no. 2 (Civil authority).

**Sequence:** H.1 Creed > H.2 Confession of sins > H.3 The Word & its fruit > H.4 Civil authority > H.5 The present congregation > H.6 Ministers of the Word > H.7 Peace > H.8 Lord's Prayer > H.9 Special intercessions.

**H.1 Creed**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Rubric (Low German).** Exhortatio edder vormaninge up dem predickstole na der predige:

**Rubric (English).** Exhortation or admonition from the pulpit after the sermon:

**Bid (Low German).** Leven frunde in Christo, spreket mit my den loven. Ick love in Got den Vader, almechtigen etc.

**Bid (English).** Dear friends in Christ, say with me the Creed. I believe in God the Father Almighty, etc.

**H.2 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Bid (Low German).** Spreket ock de bicht mit my unde bekennet Gade jue sunde, dat uns Got gnedich sy.

**Bid (English).** Say also the confession with me, and confess your sins unto God, that God may be gracious unto us.

**Prayer (Low German).** Got sy gnedich my arme sunder. Id feylet my an deme loven, dat ick Got mynen Heren nicht van ganzeme herten leve, my nicht ganzlick up em vorlate in anvechtingen unde aller nöt lives unde der selen. Ick scholde alleyne Got fruchten unde in allen dingen vor ogene hebben, nu fruchte ick my vor de lüde, de my umme der gerechticheit willen konen bose dohn. Ick fruchte vor myn gut, ere, fruntschop unde lyff to vorlesende. Ick sorge vor de neringe unchristlick unde söke in allen dingen dat myne unde nicht, wat Gades is. Ock stelle ick nicht ganz myne salicheit in Jesum Christum, synen eyngebarn Sone, vor uns gegeven. Id feylet my ock an der leve, dat ick mynen negesten nicht leve alse my sulvest, sonder handele wedder en mit bosen vordechtnissen, mit achterkosen, mit worden, mit werken unde kan nicht eyn wort van em

wedder mick liden. Ick swige denne mehr unde kan em nicht van herten vorgeven unde bun doch sulcks schuldich to dohn. Besundergen hebbe ick eyne beswerde conscientie in disser anvechtinge: N., in disser sunden: N. (Eyn jewelick klage Gade syne heymelike beswerlike sunde tor beteringe). Darumme, almechtige Got, leve Vader, vorgiff my alle myne sunde unde erlüchte myn herte mit dyner warheit, dat ick dick mach holden vor mynen gnedigen Vader unde mynen negesten vor mynen broder ane alle ergernisse nach dyneme worde dorch unsen Heren Jesum Christum. (spreket:) Amen. Jesus Christus is unse salicheit ewichlick. (spreket:) Amen.

**Prayer (English).** God be merciful to me a poor sinner. I fail in faith, in that I love not God my Lord with my whole heart, nor trust wholly in him in temptations and in all need of body and soul. I ought to fear God alone and have him before mine eyes in all things; but now I fear the people that can do me evil for righteousness' sake. I fear to lose my goods, honour, friendship and life. I care for my living in unchristian wise, and seek in all things mine own, and not the things that are God's. Neither do I set my salvation wholly in Jesus Christ, his only-begotten Son, given for us. I fail also in love, in that I love not my neighbour as myself, but deal against him with evil suspicions, with backbiting, with words, with works, and can bear no word from him against me. I keep silence then the more, and cannot forgive him from the heart, and yet am bound to do so. Especially I have a burdened conscience in this temptation: N., in this sin: N. (Let every one bewail unto God his secret, grievous sin, unto amendment.) Therefore, almighty God, dear Father, forgive me all my sins, and enlighten my heart with thy truth, that I may hold thee for my gracious Father, and my neighbour for my brother, without all offence, according to thy word; through our Lord Jesus Christ. (Say:) Amen. Jesus Christ is our salvation for ever. (Say:) Amen.

**H.3 The Word & its fruit**

*Witnesses:* Osnabrück 1543.

**Bid (Low German).** Nach der uhtlegginge des evangelii schal de pastor de worde des catechismi affseggen umb des gemeinen volkes willen und darnach vermanen to bidden, ersten vor de sake des hilligen evangelii,

**Bid (English).** After the exposition of the Gospel the pastor shall say over the words of the catechism for the sake of the common people, and thereafter exhort them to pray: first, for the cause of the holy Gospel;

**H.4 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Bid (Low German).** So lat uns nu vlitich bidden vor keyserlike majestat, vor konnige, vor heren, fursten, furstenrede unde stadrede, eddele lüde, borgermeystere unde richtere unde allen, den dat werlike swert bevalen is, besundergen vor unsen landesfursten unde vor den radt disser stadt, dat Got mit syner gnaden stedes by en sy unde geve en, dat se unstrafflick mogen regeren in den werliken dingen, de en bevalen synt, dat wy under en mögen eyn rowelick unde stille leven vohren mit aller gotsalicheit unde redelicheit.

**Bid (English).** Let us now pray diligently for the Imperial Majesty, for kings, for lords, princes, princes' counsellors and town councillors, noblemen, burgomasters and judges, and all to whom the temporal sword is committed, especially for our prince of the land and for the council of this city, that God may be always with them with his grace, and grant them that they may rule unblameably in the temporal things that are committed unto them, that we under them may lead a quiet and still life in all godliness and honesty.

**H.5 The present congregation**

*Witnesses:* Osnabrück 1543.

**Bid (Low German).** tom drudden vor de ganzen gemeine und vor alle andere not lives und der sehlen, dar men des vor begeren iß und Gade bekant. Darnach sall werden gesungen: Verlehne uns frede gnädiglich.

**Bid (English).** thirdly, for the whole congregation and for all other need of body and soul, wherefor it is desired and is known to God. Thereafter shall be sung: Grant us peace graciously.

**H.6 Ministers of the Word**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Bid (Low German).** Biddet ock vor de prestere, de uns armen schapen weyden mit deme wörde unde evangelio Christi, dat se uns mit vulstendigeme herten dat reyne wort Gades vordregen to unser beteringe unde werden behödet vor allen erdöm unde gesterket to alleme besten wedder den düvel unde alle weddersagere, dat jo dat evangelion Christi by uns reyne blive.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for the priests that feed us poor sheep with the word and Gospel of Christ, that they may set forth unto us the pure word of God with a steadfast heart to our amendment, and be kept from all error and strengthened unto all good against the devil and all gainsayers, that the Gospel of Christ may ever remain pure among us.

**H.7 Peace**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Bid (Low German).** Biddet ock umme eynen tidliken frede, vor kranke, swake, elende, anvechtede lüde, vor swangere frauen, vor unse vyende, vor alle nöt lives unde der selen. Amen. Lattet uns bidden den eynen vor den anderen, dat wy alle salich werden. Amen.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for temporal peace; for the sick, the weak, the wretched and tempted folk; for women with child; for our enemies; for all need of body and soul. Amen. Let us pray one for another, that we may all be saved. Amen.

**H.8 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Bid (Low German).** Spreket eyn Vader unse etc.

**Bid (English).** Say an Our Father, etc.

**H.9 Special intercessions**

*Witnesses:* Braunschweig 1528 and Hamburg 1529.

**Rubric (Low German).** So etlike sunderge gemeyne nöde vohrvallen, alse to bidden vor dat körne, hoppen, früchte, vor eyn tidlick weder, wedder böse tucht unde pestilentie etc., dat kan me wol mit inbringen.

**Rubric (English).** If any special common needs befall, as to pray for the corn, hops, fruits, for seasonable weather, against evil murrain and pestilence, etc., that may well be brought in therewith.

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## 6.13 Family I: Huberinus Vorbitt (Lord’s-Prayer order)

Caspar Huberinus' "Vorbitt", whose first part is arranged by the petitions of the Lord's Prayer.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Öhringen 1544 (Huberinus).
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Öhringen 1544):** After the sermon; closes with the Our Father, a declaration that the prayer is heard, and a reminder of the alms.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1544 | Öhringen (Hohenlohe), Vermahnungen und Gebete für den Gottesdienst (Caspar Huberinus) | County of Hohenlohe (Öhringen) | Sehling 15, Nr. 3 (Vermahnungen und Gebete 1544–1550), pp. 39–40 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |

**Sequence:** I.1 Exhortation / preface > I.2 Civil authority > I.3 The persecuted > I.4 Peace > I.5 Repentance & forgiveness > I.6 Women with child > I.7 Special intercessions > I.8 Lord's Prayer > I.9 Conclusion.

**I.1 Exhortation / preface**

**Rubric (German).** Eine kurtze vermanung und vorbitt, für die christlichen stend zu bitten

**Rubric (English).** A short exhortation and intercession, to pray for the Christian estates

**Bid (German).** Dieweil wir nun jetzunder allhie beyeinander versammlet seind nach Gottes bevelch, sein heylsams wort zu hören und volgents auch unser gebett zu tun zu Gott dem Herren, in dem namen Christi umb allerley anligende not der gantzen christenheyt, so wöllen wir Gott den Allmechtigen, unsern himmlischen vatter, auß kindlicher zuversicht mit glaubigem hertzen anruffen und bitten, das er uns gnediglich erhören und geweren wölle, von wegen seiner götlichen warheit und verheyssung, so uns durch seinen lieben son zugesagt ist worden, das uns Got der Herr erstlich und fürnemlich sein heyligs wort, das gnadenreyche evangelion auß vätterlicher trew wölle mitteilen, verleyhen, schützen und erhalten, auf das wir dasselbig reyn und lauter mit rechtem verstand mögen verkündigen, hören und folg tun, das dardurch sein nam unter uns und in aller welt geheyliget und gepreyset werde. Gott der Herr wölle auch alle falsche lehr, irrtum und ketzerey außreuten und uns gnediglich darvor behütten, auf das sein reich zu uns komme und uns regiere mit seinem wort, gnaden und Heiligen Geist, dardurch des Satans, Machomets und Antichristens reich ein ende nemme, verheret und verstöret werde. Damit also sein vätterlicher will geschehe, nit des fleysches, der welt und des Satans will, sondern sein will geschehe hie unter uns auf erden wie droben im hymmel. Darzu wölle Gott der Allmechtig allenthalben verordnen, erhalten, schützen und behüten alle trewe bischof, pfarherrn, prediger und kirchendiener.

**Bid (English).** Forasmuch as we are now here gathered together according to God’s commandment, to hear his wholesome word and thereafter also to make our prayer unto God the Lord in the name of Christ for all manner of pressing need of the whole of Christendom, we will call upon God the Almighty, our heavenly Father, out of childlike confidence with believing hearts, and pray him that he would graciously hear and grant us, for the sake of his divine truth and promise which hath been made us by his dear Son: that God the Lord would first and chiefly, out of fatherly faithfulness, impart, vouchsafe, defend and preserve unto us his holy word, the gracious Gospel, that we may preach, hear and obey the same purely and clearly with right understanding, that thereby his name may be hallowed and praised among us and in all the world. That God the Lord would also root out all false doctrine, error and heresy, and graciously keep us therefrom, that his kingdom may come to us and rule us with his word, grace and Holy Spirit, whereby the kingdom of Satan, of Mahomet and of Antichrist may come to an end and be laid waste and destroyed; that so his fatherly will may be done, not the will of the flesh, the world and Satan, but his will be done here among us on earth as above in heaven. Moreover, that God Almighty would everywhere ordain, preserve, defend and guard all faithful bishops, pastors, preachers and ministers of the Church.

**I.2 Civil authority**

**Bid (German).** Wir wöllen auch bitten für die christlichen oberkeyt, für Keyserliche und Königliche Mayestet, für alle churfürsten, fürsten, herren und alle stend des Reychs. In sonderheyt aber lasset uns bitten für unsere schutzherrn und potentaten, deßgleychen auch für ihre rät, amptleut und diener. Gott der Herr wölle ihnen allen miteinander geben ware forcht Gottes, weyßheyt und verstand, seliglich und wol zu regieren, auf das wir unter ihrem regiment mögen noch lenger haben Gottes wort, zeytlichen fried und narung.

**Bid (English).** We will also pray for the Christian magistrates, for the Imperial and Royal Majesty, for all Electors, princes, lords and all the estates of the Empire. But especially let us pray for our protecting lords and potentates, and likewise for their counsellors, officers and servants. God the Lord give them all together the true fear of God, wisdom and understanding to rule blessedly and well, that under their government we may yet longer have God’s word, temporal peace and sustenance.

**I.3 The persecuted**

**Bid (German).** Wir wöllen auch Gott in sonderheyt ferner anrüffen und bitten, das er die werden christenheit, so allenthalben betrengt, geenstigt und verfolgt wird von den unglaubigen, dem Türken, machometischen, widerchristischen, blutdürstigen leuten, das Got die armen christen gnediglich schützen, retten und im rechten glauben erhalten wölle.

**Bid (English).** We will also call upon God especially further and pray him for worthy Christendom, which everywhere is oppressed, afflicted and persecuted by the unbelievers, the Turk, Mahometan, antichristian, bloodthirsty people: that God would graciously defend and deliver the poor Christians and keep them in the right faith.

**I.4 Peace**

**Bid (German).** Lasset uns auch bitten für alle christliche untertanen, das sie Gott der Herr in schuldiger pflicht und gehorsam gnediglich erhalten wölle und sie behüten vor zwitracht, aufruhr und uns alle also vätterlich schützen und bewaren vor krieg, blutvergiessen, teurung, seuche, pestilentz, hagel, schaur, schedlichem ungewitter, vor allem unziffer, vergiftem luft und dergleichen, auf das wir unser teglich brot in aller stille, fried, ruhe und gesundheyt bekommen mögen.

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray for all Christian subjects, that God the Lord would graciously keep them in due duty and obedience and guard them from discord and uproar, and so defend and preserve us all in fatherly wise from war, bloodshed, dearth, sickness, pestilence, hail, storm, hurtful tempest, from all vermin, poisoned air and the like, that we may receive our daily bread in all stillness, peace, rest and health.

**I.5 Repentance & forgiveness**

**Bid (German).** Lasset uns auch bitten, das uns Gott der Herr unsere schuld gnediglich verzeihen wölle, verschonen unsers gebrechlichen lebens, die alten und vorigen sünd nicht zurechnen, sondern auß gnaden verzeihen in Christo unserm herrn. Wölle uns auch ein solch hertz geben, das wir auß rechtem grund können verzeihen unsern mißgünnern und feinden, damit wir ein liebreich hertz haben gegen unserm nehesten. Gott der Herr wölle uns auch nit in anfechtung füren und nit in versuchung fallen lassen, sondern uns auß gnaden erhalten, damit wir nit in die schedlichen versuchung und anreitzung fallen des fleisches, der welt und des Satans. Sonder Gott der Almechtig wölle uns erlösen von dem bösen, von allem ubel leibs und der seelen, zeitlichem und ewigen schaden.

**Bid (English).** Let us also pray that God the Lord would graciously forgive us our debt, spare our frail life, not impute the old and former sins, but forgive them of grace in Christ our Lord; that he would also give us such an heart that we can forgive from the right ground them that grudge against us and our enemies, that we may have a loving heart toward our neighbour. That God the Lord would also not lead us into temptation nor let us fall into trial, but keep us of grace, that we fall not into the hurtful temptation and enticement of the flesh, the world and Satan; but that God Almighty would deliver us from evil, from all harm of body and soul, temporal and eternal.

**I.6 Women with child**

**Bid (German).** In sonderheit lasset uns bitten für alle schwangere und geberende frawen, für witwen und waysen, für die liebe jugent, für die ehleut, sonderlich wo der böse feind seinen samen geseet hat, zwitracht, verbitterung und uneinigkeit, das sich auch die nachbaurn einig, fridlich, gutwillig, dienstlich und liebreich gegeneinander erzeigen.

**Bid (English).** In especial let us pray for all women with child and in travail, for widows and orphans, for the dear youth, for married folk, especially where the evil enemy hath sown his seed, discord, bitterness and disunity; that neighbours also may show themselves one toward another united, peaceable, well-willing, serviceable and loving.

**I.7 Special intercessions**

**Bid (German).** Bittet zum beschluß für etliche kranke, angefochtne, kleinmütige und trostlose personen, welche sich in sonderheit in ewer christlich gebett trewlich befelhen. Bittet auch für die, für welche wir sonderlich schuldig seind zu bitten, so uns in unser ampt und gebett befolhen sein.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye in conclusion for certain sick, tempted, fainthearted and comfortless persons, which commend themselves faithfully in especial to your Christian prayer. Pray ye also for them for whom we are especially bound to pray, which are commended to us in our office and prayer.

**I.8 Lord's Prayer**

**Bid (German).** Für dise und alle andere not der gantzen christenheyt, auch für uns selber und die unsern, wöllen wir Gott den Herrn von hertzen anruffen. Darumb tut ewer gebet zu Gott dem Almechtigen in dem namen unsers Herrn von gantzem hertzen und bettet mit andacht inniglich von hertzen ein Vatter unser.

**Bid (English).** For this and all other need of the whole of Christendom, and also for ourselves and ours, we will call upon God the Lord from the heart. Therefore make your prayer to God Almighty in the name of our Lord with your whole heart, and pray

with devotion, inwardly, from the heart, an Our Father.

**I.9 Conclusion**

**Rubric (German).** Nach dem gebet der beschluß:

**Rubric (English).** After the prayer, the conclusion:

**Prayer (German).** Der allmechtige Gott hat unser gebett nach seiner göttlichen verheissung gnediglich erhöret in Christo, unserm herrn. Dem sey lob, ehr, ruhm und preiß immer und ewiglich. Amen. Lasset euch die armen und dürftigen in ewer handreichung trewlich befolhen sein.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God hath graciously heard our prayer according to his divine promise, in Christ our Lord. To him be laud, honour, glory and praise, now and for ever. Amen. Let the poor and needy be faithfully commended to you in your almsgiving.

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## 6.14 Family J: Lower Saxon notel (Lüneburg/Wolfenbüttel)

Lower Saxon exhortation to prayer read "from the notel" after the sermon; passed verbatim to Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Lüneburg 1564.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** bidding exhortation + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Lüneburg 1564):** At the end of the sermon (never between the Gospel reading and its exposition, except for a woman in childbirth or one in peril of death); the communicants then come into the choir and kneel.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1564 | Braunschweig-Lüneburg (Celle), Kirchenordnung 1564 | Duchy of Braunschweig-Lüneburg (Lüneburg) | Sehling 6/1, II/4, pp. 545–546 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1569 | Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Kirchenordnung (Herzog Julius; Chemnitz/Andreae) | Duchy of Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel | Sehling 6/1, I/3, pp. 145–146 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |
| 1573 | Oldenburg, Kirchenordnung 1573 (Graf Anton I.) | County of Oldenburg | Sehling 7/2, VI/Oldenburg Nr. 26 (KO 1573), pp. 1146–1147 | bidding exhortation + Lord’s Prayer |

The magistrates are prayed for twice: for the Emperor and all magistrates (J.2), and, after a thanksgiving for the princes of the land, for the princess and the young lordship (J.4).

**Sequence:** J.1 The Word & its fruit > J.2 Civil authority > J.3 Thanksgiving > J.4 Civil authority > J.5 The afflicted > J.6 Deliverance from calamities > J.7 Lord's Prayer > J.8 Special intercessions.

**J.1 The Word & its fruit**

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Rubric (German).** Darauf sol das volk abermal zum gebet und danksagung gegen Gott vermanet werden und samptlich vor erhaltung der kirchen Gottes und rechter lere, darzu der treuen warhaftigen lerer und das Gott treue arbeiter in seine ernte senden wolle, für die oberkeit, für zeitlichen friede und gewechs der früchte und in summa für die not der ganzen christenheit und sonderbarer personen, die des christlichen gebets begeren, wie des ungefehrlich eine notel folget.

**Rubric (English).** Thereupon the people shall again be exhorted to prayer and thanksgiving toward God, and all together for the preservation of the Church of God and of right doctrine, and moreover of the faithful, true teachers, and that God would send faithful labourers into his harvest; for the magistrates, for temporal peace and the growth of the fruits; and in sum for the need of the whole of Christendom and of particular persons that desire the Christian prayer; whereof a draft followeth, after this manner.

**Bid (German).** Lieben Christen, last uns Gott bitten, das er uns bey seinem göttlichen wort wolle gnediglich erhalten und getreue arbeiter in seine ernte senden, den predigern und kirchendienern seinen heiligen Geist verleihen, das sie dasselbige rein und recht fürtragen und leren, auch mit gottseligem leben fürgehen und das der allmechtige wolle sie und uns vor falscher lere gnediglich behüten und derselbigen steuren und wehren. Das er auch unsern brüdern und schwestern, die mit falscher lere oder sonst mit unrechter gewalt von unchristen oder andern tyrannen angefochten und beschwert werden, gnediglich helfen wolle, das sie in warem glauben und gedult bestendig bleiben, und so möglich, die verfolgung von ihnen genomen oder gemiltert werde.

**Bid (English).** Dear Christians, let us pray God that he would graciously keep us in his divine word, and send faithful labourers into his harvest; vouchsafe his Holy Spirit unto the preachers and ministers of the Church, that they may set forth and teach the same purely and rightly, and also go before with godly life; and that the Almighty would graciously keep them and us from false doctrine, and restrain and withstand the same. That he would also graciously help our brethren and sisters which are assailed and oppressed with false doctrine or else with unrighteous violence by unchristian men or other tyrants, that they may abide steadfast in true faith and patience, and, if it be possible, that the persecution may be taken from them or mitigated.

**J.2 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Bittet auch vor weltliche oberkeiten, keyserliche majestät und andere potentaten, auch alle andere, die im ampt der oberkeit sitzen, das der allmechtige wolle diejenige, die durch Gottes wort erleuchtet sein, darbey gnediglich erhalten, denen aber, so noch nicht erleuchtet, seine gnade geben, das sie Gottes wort in ihren landen leiden und annemen. Welche aber das nicht thun wollen und es verfolgen, das er denselbigen steuren und ihr fürnemen schanden machen wolle.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for the temporal magistrates, the Imperial Majesty and other potentates, and all others that sit in the office of magistracy: that the Almighty would graciously keep therein them that are enlightened by God’s word, but give his grace unto them that are not yet enlightened, that they may suffer and receive God’s word in their lands; but that he would restrain them that will not do so and persecute it, and bring their purpose to shame.

**J.3 Thanksgiving**

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Sonderlich danket Gott, das er unsere gnedige landsfürsten und herrn also begnadet hat, das sie Gottes wort lieb haben und in ihrem land predigen lassen und fördern, und bittet, das sie der allmechtige darbey wolle gnediglich erhalten und derselben gottselig langes leben, gesundheit und gnad verleihen, das sie ihr regiment also füren, das es Gott zu ehren und ihren fürstlichen gnaden und derselbigen unterthanen zu gutem gereiche, und wir ein still friedlich leben in aller gottseligkeit unter ihnen füren mögen.

**Bid (English).** Especially give thanks to God that he hath so graced our gracious princes and lords of the land that they love God’s word and let it be preached and further it in their land; and pray that the Almighty would graciously keep them therein and vouchsafe him godly long life, health and grace, that they may so lead their government that it may redound to the honour of God and to the good of their princely Graces and their subjects, and that we may lead a quiet, peaceable life under them in all godliness.

**J.4 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Bittet auch vor unsere gnedige landsfürstin, das sie der allmechtig auch in seinem gnedigen schutz haben und sie vor allem unheil behüten und an leib und seel segnen wolle. Bittet auch vor die rethe, ampt und befelhaber, auch den radt

dieser stadt, das ihnen Gott wolle gnade geben, das sie wol raten und ihren befohlenen ampten und befehlichen getreulichen fürstehen und ausrichten.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for our gracious princess of the land, that the Almighty would have her also in his gracious protection, guard her from all mischief, and bless her in body and soul. Pray ye also for the counsellors, officers and governors, and also the council of this town, that God would give them grace to counsel well and faithfully to preside over and perform the offices and charges committed unto them.

#### J.5 The afflicted

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Bittet auch vor alle angefochten und betrübte herzen, vor alle kranken, schwangere frauen, junge kinder und alle, so in nöten sein, das der allmechtige wolle dieselbigen alle trösten, behüten und ihnen in ihren nöten beystehen und zu hülf komen.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye also for all tempted and sorrowful hearts, for all the sick, women with child, young children, and all that are in need, that the Almighty would comfort and guard them all, and stand by them and come to their help in their needs.

#### J.6 Deliverance from calamities

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Bittet vor uns alle in dieser gemein und in dem ganzen lande, das Gott uns wolle gnedig sein und behüten vor krieg, pestilenz und teuer zeit, vor feuer und wassersnot, vor hagel und ungewitter und vor allem unglücke und ubel und wolle die früchte auf dem felde behüten, segen und gnade geben, das wir sie mit fried, gesundheit und danksagung geniessen mögen.

**Bid (English).** Pray ye for us all in this congregation and in the whole land, that God would be gracious unto us and keep us from war, pestilence and dearth, from fire and flood, from hail and tempest, and from all mischance and evil; and that he would guard the fruits upon the field and give blessing and grace, that we may enjoy them with peace, health and thanksgiving.

#### J.7 Lord's Prayer

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Bid (German).** Ein jeder trage Gott seine eigen not für und betet in dem namen Christi auf seine zusagung, da er spricht: Alles, was ihr bittet in meinem namen, gleubet, so werdet ihr es haben, und sprecht von grund des herzens: Vater unser etc.

**Bid (English).** Let every one lay his own need before God, and pray ye in the name of Christ upon his promise, where he saith: Whatsoever ye ask in my name, believe, and ye shall have it; and say from the ground of the heart: Our Father, etc.

#### J.8 Special intercessions

*Witnesses:* Lüneburg 1564, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Oldenburg 1573.

**Rubric (German).** Wenn denn etwas fürfellet, davon sonderliche bit zu thun ist, als vor sonderliche kranken, vor frauen, die in kindesnöten sein, und was sonst vor not und sachen des landes oder sonderer personen fürfallen, das sol diesem gemeinem gebet auch mit kurzen worten angehangen werden.

**Rubric (English).** If then aught befall whereof special petition is to be made, as for particular sick persons, for women that are in the pains of childbirth, and whatsoever else of need and matters of the land or of particular persons may befall, that shall be added to this common prayer also in short words.

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### 6.15 Family K: Three collects from the pulpit

After an exhortation the minister reads three collects from the pulpit: thanksgiving or the Church, the magistrates, and a special need, chosen from a bank.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Worms 1560.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** exhortation + three collects.
- **Place in the service (Worms 1560):** On Sundays and feasts, when the choir has finished the first psalm or hymn, the minister goes into the pulpit, exhorts the people to prayer and reads three collects: (1) a thanksgiving for God's gifts or a prayer for the preservation of the Church and God's word (on feasts, a thanksgiving for the feast), (2) for the magistrates, (3) a special prayer as the time requires (peace, protection, fruits of the earth, rain …).

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1560 | Worms, Agendbüchlein 1560 | Worms (Imperial city) | Sehling 19, III/4, pp. 178–183 | exhortation + three collects |

Worms reads three collects from the pulpit: a thanksgiving, or a prayer for the Church and God's word; one for the magistrates; and a third that varies with the time, chosen from the collect bank that follows in the order. K.2 and K.3 are the two texts for the first collect, K.4 is the collect for the magistrates, and K.5 is the rubric for the third.

**Sequence:** K.1 Exhortation / preface > K.2 Thanksgiving > K.3 The Church > K.4 Civil authority > K.5 Special intercessions.

#### K.1 Exhortation / preface

**Rubric (German).** VI. Vom gemeinen Gebett. Wiewol zu ende aller Predigten das Volck ernstlich und vleissig für alle noth und anligen der gantzen Christenheit im Geistlichen, Weltlichen und Haußregiment zubitten, Auch zur danckbarkeit gegen Gott für seine grosse und manigfältige wolthaten genugsam ermahnet wirdt, Jedoch so werden umb mehrer erinnerung willen auch etliche andere gemeine Gebett und Collecten gehalten und dem Volck deutlich fürgelesen inn volgender ordnung. Am Sontag und Feiertagen, wann der Chor den ersten Psalm oder Geistlichen Gesang vollendet hat, so gehet der Kirchendiener auff die Cantzel und ermahnet das Volck zum Gebett und liset ihnen je auff einmal drey Collecten für. Die erste ist entzweder ein gemeine dancksagung für allerley Gottes gaben oder ein gebett umb erhaltung der Kirchen und Göttlichs Worts oder, so es an sonderlichen Festen ist, eine dancksagung für dieselbigen sonderen gaben, darvon man auff dasselbige Fest pfleget zu handeln. Die ander von Weltlicher Oberkeit. Die dritt ist Specialis und nach gelegenheit der zeit, eintzweder umb fried oder umb schutz oder für die früchte der Erden oder für regen etc. und was dergleichen für sonderbare noth und anligen mehr fürfallen, davon man die Christliche Kirch erinnern muß, auß nachgehender verzeichnuß.

**Rubric (English).** VI. Of the common prayer. Although at the end of all sermons the people are sufficiently exhorted to pray earnestly and diligently for all the need and concerns of the whole of Christendom in the spiritual, temporal and household government, and also to thankfulness toward God for his great and manifold benefits, yet for the sake of greater remembrance certain other common prayers and collects are also held and read plainly to the people in the following order. On Sundays and feast days, when the choir hath finished the first psalm or spiritual song, the minister goeth into the pulpit and exhorteth the people to prayer, and readeth to them three collects at a time. The first is either a common thanksgiving for all manner of God's gifts, or a prayer for the preservation of the Church and God's word, or, if it be on special feasts, a thanksgiving for those special gifts whereof it is wont to be treated on that feast. The second is of the temporal magistrates. The third is special, according to the occasion of the time: either for peace, or for protection, or for the fruits of the earth, or for rain, etc., and whatsoever like special need and concern may befall, whereof the Christian Church must be put in mind, out of the register following.

#### K.2 Thanksgiving

**Rubric (German).** Ein gemeine dancksagung für allerley wolthaten Gottes.

**Rubric (English).** A common thanksgiving for all manner of benefits of God.

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger Herr Gott, Himlischer Vatter, von dem wir on unterlaß allerley gutes gantz uberflüssig entpfahen und teglich vor allem ubel stattlich und gnediglich behütet werden, Wir bitten Dich, gib uns durch Deinen Geist, solches alles mit gantzem hertzen inn rechtem Glauben zu erkennen, auff das wir Deiner milten güte und Barmhertzigkeit hie und dort Ewigklich dancken und Dich loben, Durch unsern Herrn Jhesum Christum, Deinen lieben Son etc.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty Lord God, heavenly Father, of whom we without ceasing receive all manner of good right abundantly, and are daily kept from all evil stately and graciously: we beseech thee, give us by thy Spirit to acknowledge all this

with our whole heart in right faith, that we may thank thy bountiful goodness and mercy here and there eternally, and praise thee; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy dear Son, etc.

**K.3 The Church**

**Rubric (German).** Umb erhaltung und fruchtbar gedeien Göttlichs worts.

**Rubric (English).** For the preservation and fruitful increase of God's word.

**Prayer (German).** Allmechtiger Gott, Wir bitten Dich, gibe Deiner gemein Deinen Geist und Göttliche Weißheit, das Dein wort unter uns lauffe und wachse und mit aller freidigkeit, wie sichs gebüret, geprediget und Dein Heilige Christliche gemein dardurch gebessert werde, auff das wir mit bestendigem glauben Dir dienen und inn bekandtnuß Deines namens biß ans ende verharren, Durch unsern Herren etc.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God, we beseech thee, give unto thy congregation thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the confession of thy name unto the end; through our Lord, etc.

**K.4 Civil authority**

**Rubric (German).** Für Weltliche Obrigkeit allein.

**Rubric (English).** For the temporal magistrates alone.

**Prayer (German).** O Barmhertziger Himlischer Vatter, inn welches handt bestehet aller menschen gewalt und wolfart der frommen, inn welches handt auch stehen alle Recht und Gesetz aller Reich auff Erden, Wir bitten Dich, sihe gnedigklich auff Deine Diener, den Römischen Keyser, alle König, Fürsten und Christliche Obrigkeit, damit sie das Weltliche schwerdt, ihnen von Dir befohlen, nach Deinem befehl führen mögen, Erleuchte und erhalte sie bey Deinem Göttlichen namen, gibe ihnen, lieber Herr, Weißheit und verstandt und ein friedlich Regiment, auff das sie ihre Unterthanen inn fried, rhue und einigkeit beschirmen und regieren, Erlengere ihnen, O Gott unsers Heils, ire tag, auff das wir, unter ihrer Herrschaft, Deinen Göttlichen namen, sampt ihnen, heiligen und preisen mögen, Durch unsern Herrn Jhesum Christum etc.

**Prayer (English).** O merciful heavenly Father, in whose hand standeth all power of men and the welfare of the godly, in whose hand also stand all the rights and laws of all realms upon earth: we beseech thee, look graciously upon thy servants, the Roman Emperor, all kings, princes and Christian magistrates, that they may bear the temporal sword, committed unto them of thee, according to thy commandment. Enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may defend and rule their subjects in peace, rest and unity. Prolong their days, O God of our salvation, that under their dominion we together with them may hallow and praise thy divine name; through our Lord Jesus Christ, etc.

**K.5 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (German).** Die dritt ist Specialis … auß nachgehender verzeichnuß.

**Rubric (English).** The third is special … out of the register following.

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## 6.16 Family L: Intercessions under the Sanctus (Brandenburg 1540)

Not a pulpit prayer but collects said by the priest in the Mass under the Sanctus, for ministers, magistrates and peace, in the place the Roman Canon had its intercessions. Followed by Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Brandenburg 1540.
- **Tradition:** Lutheran.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** collects said by the priest under the Sanctus.

- **Place in the service (Brandenburg 1540):** In the Mass, after the Preface, while the Latin Sanctus is sung; followed by the Verba (sung in German, with elevation) and the Our Father. The prayers stand where the Roman Canon had its intercessions.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1540 | Mark Brandenburg, Kirchenordnung (Kurfürst Joachim II.) | Electorate of Brandenburg | Sehling 3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3, pp. 68–69 | collects said by the priest |
| 1542 | Calenberg-Göttingen, Kirchenordnung (Herzogin Elisabeth; Corvinus) | Principality of Calenberg-Göttingen | Sehling 6/2, III/Calenberg-Göttingen, p. 815 | collect said by the priest |
| 1543 | Pfalz-Neuburg, Kirchenordnung (Pfalzgraf Ottheinrich; Osiander) | Palatinate-Neuburg | Sehling 13, I.2, p. 74 | collects said by the priest |

Each collect ends "durch deinen son Jesum Christum, amen." in place of the abbreviation "durch unsern herrn etc." (Introduction, Representative texts, rule 4).

**Sequence:** L.1 Civil authority > L.2 Ministers of the Word > L.3 Peace > L.4 Repentance & forgiveness > L.5 Lord's Prayer.

#### L.1 Civil authority

*Witnesses:* Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

**Rubric (German).** Unter dem sanctus sol der priester folgende oration deudsch beten. ¶ Fur die oberigkeit.

**Rubric (English).** Under the Sanctus the priest shall pray the following prayer in German. ¶ For the magistrates.

**Prayer (German).** Barmherziger himlischer vater, in welches hende aller menschen gewalt und obrigkeit stehet, von dir eingesetzt zur straf der ubeltheter und zum schutz der fromen, in welches hende auch stehen alle recht und gesetze aller lender, wir bitten dich, sei gnedig unserm herrn kaiser, allen königen und fürsten, sonderlich unserm landesfursten und herrn N. und dem rath und regenten dieser stadt und aller ordenlichen obrigkeit, damit sie das weltlich schwerd, das du inen befohlen hast, recht füren mügen; umschattige sie mit der kraft des allerhöchsten, erleucht und erhalt sie bei deinem göttlichen namen, lass sie dein göttlichs wort von herzen lieb haben und darüber fest halten und sie ja dasselbig nicht lassen verfolgen, gib inen, lieber herr, weisheit und einen verstand und ein fridsam regiment, auf das sie alle ire unterthanen in der warheit und gerechtigkeit, die dir gefellig ist, regiren und beschirmen, auch, mein lieber gott, friste inen ir leben lang, nach deinem willen und weil das gerichte dein ist und sie an deiner stad sitzen, gib inen gnad, also zu regiren, das dein heiliger name durch sie geheiligt und gepreiset werde, von nu an bis in ewigkeit, das helf inen der herr Jesu Christ, dein geliebter son, amen.

**Prayer (English).** Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Highest; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereto, and in no wise suffer it to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

#### L.2 Ministers of the Word

*Witnesses:* Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

**Rubric (German).** Ein ander.

**Rubric (English).** Another.

**Prayer (German).** O almechtiger gütiger gott und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, der du uns ernstlich befohlen hast, das wir dich bitten sollen um arbeiter in deiner ernten, das ist um rechtschaffne prediger deines worts. Wir bitten dein gründlose barmherzigkeit, du wollest uns rechtschaffne lerer und diener deines göttlichen worts zuschicken und denselben dein heilsams wort in das herz und in den mund geben, das sie deinen befelch treulich ausrichten und nichts predigen, das deinem heiligen wort entgegen sei, auf das wir durch dein himlisch ewigs wort ermanet, geleret, gespeist, getröst und gesterkt werden, thun, was dir gefellig und uns fruchtbarlich ist; gib herr deiner heiligen christlichen kirchen deinen geist und göttliche weisheit, das dein wort unter uns laufe und wachse und mit aller freidigkeit, wie sichs gebürt, gepredigt und dein heilige christliche gemein dadurch gebessert werde, auf das wir mit bestendigem glauben dir dienen und in erkentnis deines namens bis an das ende verharren, durch deinen son Jesum Christum, amen.

**Prayer (English).** O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hast earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest, that is, for right and true preachers of thy word: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and into their mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christian Church thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end; through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

**L.3 Peace**

*Witnesses:* Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.

**Rubric (German).** Ein ander.

**Rubric (English).** Another.

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger gott und ewiger vater, ein könig der ehren und ein herr himels und der erden, durch welches geist alle dinge regiret, durch welches fursehung alle dinge geordnet werden, du bist ein gott des friedes, von dem allein einigkeit zu uns komt, wir bitten dich durch unsern herrn Jesum Christum, du wollest uns unser sunde vergeben und mit deinem göttlichen friden und einigkeit begnaden, damit wir in forcht und zittern deinem namen dienen und allezeit von uns gepreiset werdest, amen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; thou art a God of peace, from whom alone unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling, and that thou mayest be praised of us evermore. Amen.

**L.4 Repentance & forgiveness**

*Witnesses:* Brandenburg 1540.

**Prayer (German).** Barmherziger gott und himlischer vater, des barmherzigkeit kein ende hat, der du langmütig, gnedig und von grosser güte und treu bist und vergibst alle missethat, ubertretung und sunde, wir haben leider gesundigt mit unsern vetern, wir haben mishandelt und sind gottlos gewesen und dich oftmals erzürnet, dir allein haben wir gesundigt und ubel fur dir gethan, aber herr, gedenke nicht an unsere vorige missethat, las bald dein barmherzigkeit uber uns gross sein, denn wir sind elend worden, hilf uns gott unsers heils um der ehre willen deines namens, erlöse uns und vergib uns unser sunde, durch deinen son Jesum Christum, amen.

**Prayer (English).** Merciful God and heavenly Father, whose mercy hath no end, who art longsuffering, gracious and of great goodness and faithfulness, and forgivest all iniquity, transgression and sin: we have, alas, sinned with our fathers, we have done amiss and dealt wickedly and oftentimes provoked thee to wrath; against thee only have we sinned and done evil in thy sight. But, Lord, remember not against us our former iniquities; let thy mercy speedily be great upon us, for we are brought very low. Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name; deliver us and forgive us our sins; through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

**L.5 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Brandenburg 1540, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. *Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 lacks the rubric.*

**Rubric (German).** Darauf sol, wie hernach folget, das pater noster deudsch gesungen werden.

**Rubric (English).** Thereupon the Pater noster shall be sung in German, as followeth.

**Bid (German).** Last uns beten, wie uns der herr Christus Jesus befohlen hat, das wir aus rechter zuversicht und vertrauen dorfen sagen:

**Bid (English).** Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say:

**Prayer (German).** Vater unser, der du bist im himel, geheiliget werde dein name, zukome dein reich, dein wil geschehe als im himel auch auf erden, unser teglich brod gib uns heute und vergib uns unser schulde als wir vergeben unsern schuldigern und für uns nicht in versuchung, sondern erlös uns von dem ubel, denn dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herrlichkeit in ewigkeit.

**Prayer (English).** Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth; give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever.

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## 6.17 Family M: Pulpit biddings in the Prone pattern

Early East Frisian pulpit biddings after the medieval Prone: three biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed and Our Father.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Norden 1528.
- **Tradition:** Reformed (an early East Frisian evangelical order, printed by Sehling among the Reformed orders of East Frisia).
- **Language:** Low Dutch.
- **Form:** biddings, then Decalogue, confession, Creed, Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Norden 1528):** Every Sunday after the sermon ("na dat sermoen"): three biddings, then the Ten Commandments, a confession of sins, the Creed with a confession of faith, and the Our Father.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1528 | Norden (East Frisia), Gottesdienstordnung [ca. 1528] (Reformed) | Norden, County of East Frisia | Sehling 7/1, IV/Ostfriesland Nr. 6, p. 431 | biddings + Decalogue + confession + Creed + Lord's Prayer |

**Sequence:** M.1 Civil authority > M.2 Ministers of the Word > M.3 Enemies > M.4 Ten Commandments.

**M.1 Civil authority**

**Rubric (Low Dutch).** Dese nabeschrevene manier wert geholden to Norden alle Sondaechs na dat sermoen.

**Rubric (English).** This manner written hereafter is observed at Norden every Sunday after the sermon.

**Bid (Low Dutch).** I. Laet ons aenroepen en bidden God, onsen hemelsken Vader, voor onse gnädige here mit sinen rade en amptluyden en voor alle overheit der werelt, dat hoer God regere en regeren laet na sine woerde en Geeste tot gemeinen welvaren en vrede.

**Bid (English).** I. Let us call upon and pray God, our heavenly Father, for our gracious lord with his council and officers, and for all the magistracy of the world, that God would govern them and let them govern according to his word and Spirit, unto the common welfare and peace.

**M.2 Ministers of the Word**

**Bid (Low Dutch).** II. Vor alle getrouwe dienaren en herderen der scapen Christi, dat se vrymoedeliken en eendrachteliken Gods woert voeren en den gekruysten Christum verkondigen.

**Bid (English).** II. For all faithful ministers and shepherds of the sheep of Christ, that they may set forth God's word boldly and with one accord, and preach Christ crucified.

**M.3 Enemies**

**Bid (Low Dutch).** III. Item voer alle onse vyanden en alle ongelovigen: heiden, Joden, Turken en valsche Christen, dat se God met sinen woerde en Geeste verlichte en hem goede herderen geve. Laet ons onse krancheit en sonden bekennen, die ons ut Gods geset en geboden werden openbaert.

**Bid (English).** III. Item, for all our enemies and all unbelievers: heathen, Jews, Turks and false Christians, that God would enlighten them with his word and Spirit and give them good shepherds. Let us confess our weakness and sins, which are made manifest to us out of God's law and commandments.

**M.4 Ten Commandments**

**Rubric (Low Dutch).** Die tein geboden. … Ic gelove an God den Vader … Onse Vader in die hemelen …

**Rubric (English).** The Ten Commandments. … I believe in God the Father … Our Father in the heavens …

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## 6.18 Family R1: Heidelberg 1563 prayer

The Reformed Sunday prayer after the sermon: confession and absolution, a long continuous prayer (fruit of the Word, ministers, magistrates, all men, the persecuted, the afflicted, the congregation), then the Our Father. Copied in Moers, Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and, abridged, Lutheran Schaumburg 1614.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Kurpfalz 1563 (Heidelberg).
- **Tradition:** Reformed (Schaumburg 1614 Lutheran).
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (Kurpfalz 1563):** Sunday morning after the sermon: exhortation to confession, confession, absolution (with retention), then the prayer and the Our Father; a psalm and the Aaronic blessing follow. The prayer before the sermon is a separate confession of sins.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1563 | Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Friedrich III.) (Reformed) | Electoral Palatinate | Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Friedrichs III. Nr. 60 (KO 1563), pp. 389–390 | confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer |
| 1581 | Moers, Kirchenordnung [1581] (Graf Adolf von Neuenahr) (Reformed) | County of Moers | Sehling 22, III/Moers Nr. 5 (KO [1581]), pp. 182–183 | continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer |
| 1588 | Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Kirchenordnung 1588/1619 (Reformed) | Counties of Bentheim, Tecklenburg and Steinfurt | Sehling 22, IV/3, pp. 256–257 | continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer |
| 1598 | Ysenburg-Birstein, Kirchenordnung 1598 (Graf Wolfgang Ernst) (Reformed) | County of Ysenburg-Büdingen-Birstein | Sehling 10, III/Ysenburg-Birstein Nr. 17, pp. 664–666 | confession + absolution + continuous prayer + Lord's Prayer |
| 1614 | Schaumburg, Kirchenordnung 1614 (Graf/Fürst Ernst) (Lutheran) | County of Holstein-Schaumburg | Sehling 7/2.2, I/21, pp. 147–149 | confession + absolution + continuous prayer |

Schaumburg 1614 is a Lutheran order that takes over the Heidelberg confession, absolution and prayer, abridged.

**Not in the representative text** (a minority reading of its category; see the Prayers sheet or the critical sheets): Schaumburg 1614 no. 7 (Fruits of the earth).

**Sequence:** R1.1 Confession of sins > R1.2 Confession of sins > R1.3 Thanksgiving > R1.4 The Word & its fruit > R1.5 Civil authority > R1.6 Fruits of the earth > R1.7 All men > R1.8 The persecuted > R1.9 The afflicted > R1.10 Lord's Prayer.

**R1.1 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

**Rubric (German).** Am Sontag nach der morgenpredig soll der kirchendiener sprechen:

**Rubric (English).** On Sunday after the morning sermon the minister shall say:

**Bid (German).** Ir geliebten in dem herrn, Dieweil wir in den geboten Gottes gleich als in einem spiegel sehen, wie groß und vielfältig unser sünden sind, durch welche wir zeitliche und ewige straf verdienen, so laßt uns diesselbige von hertzen unserm getreuen vater bekennen, sprecht derhalben mit mir also:

**Bid (English).** Dearly beloved in the Lord, forasmuch as we see in the commandments of God as in a glass how great and manifold our sins are, whereby we deserve temporal and eternal punishment, let us confess the same from the heart unto our faithful Father; say therefore with me thus:

**Prayer (German).** Ich armer sünder bekenn für dir, meinem Gott und schöpfer, daß ich leider schwerlich und mannigfältig wider dich gesündiget hab, nicht allein mit eusserlichen groben sünden, sonder vilmehr mit innerlicher angeborner blindheyt, unglauben, zweifelung, kleinmütigkeyt, ungedult, hoffart, bösem geitz, heimlichen neid, haß und mißvergunst, auch andern bösen dücken, wie du, mein herr und Gott, an mir erkennest und ich leider nit gnugsam erkennen kan, die reuen mich und sind mir leid und beger von hertzen gnad, durch deinen lieben son Jesum Christum.

**Prayer (English).** I, poor sinner, confess before thee, my God and Creator, that I, alas, have sinned grievously and manifoldly against thee, not only with outward gross sins, but much more with inward, inborn blindness, unbelief, doubting, faintheartedness, impatience, pride, evil covetousness, secret envy, hatred and grudging, and other evil wiles, as thou, my Lord and God, knowest in me, and I, alas, cannot sufficiently know; they repent me and grieve me, and I desire grace from my heart, through thy dear Son Jesus Christ.

**R1.2 Confession of sins**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614. *Schaumburg 1614 lacks the rubric.*

**Rubric (German).** Darauf soll er den gläubigen die vergebung der sünden und den unbußfertigen das urtheil Gottes verkündigen und also sprechen:

**Rubric (English).** Thereupon he shall declare unto the faithful the forgiveness of sins, and unto the impenitent the judgement of God, and say thus:

**Prayer (German).** Nun höret an den gewissen trost der gnaden Gottes, welche er allen gläubigen in seinem evangelio verheisset. Also spricht der herr Christus Johan. am 3.: Also hat Gott die welt geliebt, daß er seinen eingebornen son gab, auf daß alle, die an in glauben, nicht verlorn werden, sonder das ewig leben haben. Sovil nun euer sein, die an ihnen selbst und an iren sünden ein mißfallen haben und vertrauen, daß sie inen durch den verdienst Jesu Christi allein gantz und gar vergeben sind, und den fürsatz haben, je lenger je mehr von sünden abzustehen und dem herrn in warer heiligkeyt und gerechtigkeyt zu dienen, denselbigen (dieweil sie glauben in den son des lebendigen Gottes) verkündige ich aus dem befelch Gottes, daß sie von allen iren sünden (wie er in seinem heiligen evangelio verheißt) in dem himmel entbunden seind durch die volkommene genugthuung des allerheiligisten leidens und sterbens unsers herrn Jesu Christi, Amen. Soviel aber under euch seind, die noch einen gefallen haben an iren sünden und schanden oder in sünden wider ir gewissen beharren, denselbigen verkündige ich auß befelch Gottes, daß der zorn und das urtheil Gottes uber inen bleibt und daß alle ire sünden im himmel gehalten seind und sie von der ewigen verdamnuß nit entbunden mögen werden, biß daß sie sich bekehren.

**Prayer (English).** Hear now the sure comfort of the grace of God, which he promiseth in his Gospel to all believers. Thus saith the Lord Christ in John the third: God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. As many of you therefore as are displeased with yourselves and your sins, and trust that they are wholly and altogether forgiven them through the merit of Jesus Christ alone, and have the purpose more and more to cease from sins and to serve the Lord in true holiness and righteousness, unto them (forasmuch as they believe in the Son of the living God) I declare by the commandment of God that they are loosed in heaven from all their sins (as he promiseth in his holy Gospel) through the perfect satisfaction of the most holy suffering and death of our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. But as many among you as yet have pleasure in their sins and shame, or continue in sins against their conscience, unto them I declare by the commandment of God that the wrath and judgement of God abideth upon them, and that all their sins are retained in heaven, and that they cannot be loosed from eternal damnation until they be converted.

**R1.3 Thanksgiving**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614. *Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 lacks the rubric. Moers 1581 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 lack the bid.*

**Rubric (German).** Gebet am Sontag nach der predigt und Absolution.

**Rubric (English).** Prayer on Sunday after the sermon and absolution.

**Bid (German).** Nachdem wir nun nicht zweifelen, wir und unser gebet seien durch das leiden Jesu Christi geheiliget und Gott angenem, so laßt uns in von hertzen anrüfen und also sprechen:

**Bid (English).** Forasmuch now as we doubt not that we and our prayer are sanctified through the suffering of Jesus Christ and acceptable unto God, let us call upon him from the heart and say thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger Gott, schöpfer himmels und der erden, wir dancken dir auß grund unsers hertzens, daß du uns erschaffen, biß auf disen tag uns und unsere kinder erhalten, gespeiset und erneret hast und noch hinfort erhalten und regieren wilst. Insonderheyt aber dancken wir dir, daß du deinen son Jesum Christum, den du im paradeiß verheissen hast, uns hast zu erkennen geben und unsere sünden durch sein bitter leiden und sterben uns verzihen.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God, Creator of heaven and of earth, we give thee thanks from the ground of our heart that thou hast created us, and unto this day hast preserved, fed and nourished us and our children, and wilt yet henceforth preserve and govern us. But especially we give thee thanks that thou hast given us to know thy Son Jesus Christ, whom thou didst promise in Paradise, and hast forgiven us our sins through his bitter suffering and death.

**R1.4 The Word & its fruit**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

**Prayer (German).** Und bitten dich, daß du uns zum ebenbildt deines sohns Jesu Christi durch die predig deines worts und kraft deines heiligen geistes erneuern wöllest, auf daß wir mit leib und seel ewig mit dir leben und dich preisen, darzu wir anfenglich erschaffen seind, und wöllest dem satan weren, daß er uns dein heiliges wort nicht auß unsern hertzen reisse, wie er unsern ersten eltern Adam und Even gethon hat.

**Prayer (English).** And we beseech thee that thou wouldest renew us unto the image of thy Son Jesus Christ through the preaching of thy word and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we may live with thee eternally in body and soul and praise thee, whereunto we were created in the beginning; and that thou wouldest withstand Satan, that he snatch not thy holy word out of our hearts, as he did to our first parents Adam and Eve.

**R1.5 Civil authority**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

**Prayer (German).** Dieweil du uns auch in diesem leben durch die handt unser oberkeyt, deiner diener, wilst regieren, so bitten wir dich, der du ihre hertzen in deiner hand hast, wöllest ihnen allen, der keyserlichen und königlichen majestat, allen fürsten und herrn, insonderheyt unserm gnedigisten chur- und landsfürsten, hertzog Friderichen, pfaltzgraven, sampt irer churfürstlichen gnaden ehegemahel, jungen herrschaft, rähten und amptleuten (auch einen erbern rath dieser statt oder einer

erbaren gemein dieses orts) gnad und einigkeyt verleihen, daß sie ire gantze regierung dahin richten, daß unser herr Jesus Christus, dem du allen gewalt im himmel und auf erden gegeben hast, uber sie und ire underthonen hersche, auf daß das arme volck, die da sind creaturn deiner hend und schaf deiner wayde, für die auch der herr Jesus sein blut vergossen hat, regiert werden in aller heiligkeyt und gerechtigkeyt, daß auch wir umb deinetwillen inen alle gebürliche ehr und treu erzeigen und under inen ein ehrbar, fridsams und christlichs leben füren mögen.

**Prayer (English).** And forasmuch as thou wilt govern us in this life also by the hand of our magistrates, thy ministers, we beseech thee, who hast their hearts in thy hand, that thou wouldest vouchsafe unto them all, the Imperial and royal Majesty, all princes and lords, especially our most gracious Elector and prince of this land, Duke Frederick, Count Palatine, together with his Electoral Grace's consort, the young lordship, counsellors and officers (and also an honourable council of this city, or an honourable commune of this place), grace and unity, that they may direct their whole government to this end, that our Lord Jesus Christ, unto whom thou hast given all power in heaven and in earth, may reign over them and their subjects; that the poor people, which are the creatures of thy hands and the sheep of thy pasture, for whom also the Lord Jesus hath shed his blood, may be governed in all holiness and righteousness; and that we also for thy sake may show them all due honour and faithfulness, and lead under them an honest, peaceable and Christian life.

**R1.6 Fruits of the earth**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

**Prayer (German).** Gib auch deinen segen und benedeiung zu der frucht der erden, auf daß wir dich dardurch als einen vater und ursprung aller barmhertzigkeyt und güter erkennen.

**Prayer (English).** Give also thy blessing and benediction to the fruit of the earth, that we may thereby acknowledge thee as a Father and fountain of all mercy and good things.

**R1.7 All men**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

**Prayer (German).** Wir bitten dich auch nicht allein für uns, sonder auch für alle menschen der gantzen welt, wöllest dich uber sie allesampt gnediglich erbarmen,

**Prayer (English).** We pray thee also not for ourselves only, but also for all men of the whole world, that thou wouldest have mercy upon them all graciously;

**R1.8 The persecuted**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

**Prayer (German).** insonderheyt aber, die unser mitglieder seind an dem leib Jesu Christi und umb deiner warheyt willen vom Türcken und bapst verfolgen leiden. Wöllest, o vater aller gnaden, solches wüten deiner feind, die deinen son Jesum Christum in seinen gliedern verfolgen, zurückhalten und die verfolgten mit unüberwindtlicher standhaftigkeyt und kraft deines heiligen geists stercken, auf daß sie solche verfolgung von deiner hand mit dancksagung annemen und in ihrem trübsal solche freund empfinden, welche ubertrifft allen verstand.

**Prayer (English).** but especially upon them that are our fellow members in the body of Jesus Christ and for thy truth's sake suffer persecution from the Turk and the Pope. Restrain, O Father of all grace, such raging of thine enemies, which persecute thy Son Jesus in his members, and strengthen the persecuted with invincible steadfastness and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that they may receive such persecution from thy hand with thanksgiving, and in their tribulation feel such joy as passeth all understanding.

**R1.9 The afflicted**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588, Ysenburg-Birstein 1598 and Schaumburg 1614.

**Prayer (German).** Tröste und stercke alle armen, gefangen, krancken, witwen und weysen, schwangere weiber und bekümmerte und angefochtene hertzen und gib ihnen deinen frieden,

**Prayer (English).** Comfort and strengthen all the poor, the captives, the sick, widows and orphans, women with child, and troubled and tempted hearts, and give them thy peace;

**R1.10 Lord's Prayer**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563, Moers 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 and Ysenburg-Birstein 1598.

**Prayer (German).** durch unsern lieben herrn Jesum Christum, welcher uns diese gwisse verheissung gethan hat: Fürwar, fürwar, sage ich euch, was ihr den vater bitten werdet in meinem namen, das wirdt er euch geben, und uns darauf hat befohlen, also zu beten: Unser vater etc.

**Prayer (English).** through our dear Lord Jesus Christ, who hath made us this sure promise: Verily, verily, I say unto you, Whatsoever ye shall ask the Father in my name, he will give it you; and hath commanded us thereupon to pray thus: Our Father, etc.

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## 6.19 Family R2: Heidelberg Lord’s-Prayer paraphrase

The Heidelberg alternative prayer paraphrasing the Lord's Prayer clause by clause (after Geneva and the Heidelberg Catechism qq. 122-127).

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Kurpfalz 1563, alternative.
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** Lord's Prayer paraphrase.
- **Place in the service (Kurpfalz 1563):** Alternative (“Oder also”) to the Sunday prayer after the sermon (after confession and absolution); followed by the Our Father, a psalm and the blessing.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1563 | Kurpfalz, Kirchenordnung (Friedrich III.) (Reformed) | Electoral Palatinate | Sehling 14, Regierungszeit Friedrichs III. Nr. 60 (KO 1563), pp. 390–391 | Lord’s Prayer paraphrase |
| 1588 | Bentheim-Tecklenburg, Kirchenordnung 1588/1619 (Reformed) | Counties of Bentheim, Tecklenburg and Steinfurt | Sehling 22, IV/3, pp. 256–258 | Lord’s Prayer paraphrase + Creed |

Each rubric is the clause of the Lord's Prayer that the paragraph expounds. Sehling prints the clauses in square brackets in Kurpfalz 1563. Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 adds R2.9.

**Sequence:** R2.1 Exhortation / preface > R2.2 The Word & its fruit > R2.3 The Church > R2.4 All estates / households > R2.5 Fruits of the earth > R2.6 Repentance & forgiveness > R2.7 The present congregation > R2.8 Conclusion > R2.9 Creed.

**R2.1 Exhortation / preface**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

**Rubric (German).** Oder also:

**Rubric (English).** Or thus:

**Prayer (German).** Almechtiger Gott, himlischer vater, der du hast uns verheissen, was wir dich in dem namen deines geliebten sohns Jesu Christi werden bitten, das wöllest du uns gewißlich geben.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God, heavenly Father, who hast promised us that whatsoever we shall ask thee in the name of thy beloved Son Jesus Christ, thou wilt surely give it us:

**R2.2 The Word & its fruit**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Geheiliget werde dein nam.

**Rubric (English).** Hallowed be thy name.

**Prayer (German).** Wir bitten dich, daß du durch deinen heiligen geist in uns wöllest würcken, daß wir dich recht erkennen und dich in allen deinen wercken, in welchen leuchtet dein allmechtigkeyt, weißheyt, güte, gerechtigkeyt, barmhertzigkeyt und warheyt, heiligen, rühmen und preisen und daß auch wir unser gantzes leben, gedancken, wort und werck dahin richten, daß dein nam umb unsertwillen nicht gelestert, sonder geehret und gepriesen werde.

**Prayer (English).** We beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that we may rightly know thee, and hallow, extol and praise thee in all thy works, wherein shineth thine almightiness, wisdom, goodness, righteousness, mercy and truth; and that we also may so direct our whole life, thoughts, words and works, that thy name be not blasphemed for our sakes, but honoured and praised.

**R2.3 The Church**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Dein reich kom.

**Rubric (English).** Thy kingdom come.

**Prayer (German).** Auch regier uns also durch das scepter deines worts und kraft deines heiligen geistes, daß wir und alle menschen uns deiner majestet von tag zu tag mehr underwerfen und ergeben, erhalt und mehre deine kirch und zerstör alle werck des teufels und alle falsche und böse rahtschläg, die wider dein heiliges wort erdacht werden. Mach zuschanden deine feind durch die macht deiner warheyt und gerechtigkeyt, daß also aller gewalt, der sich wider deine ehr erhebet, von tag zu tag mehr zerstöret und vertilget werde, biß die vollkommenheyt deines reichs herzukomme, wenn du am jüngsten gericht deine herrligkeyt in uns offenbaren und in ewigkeyt alles in allen sein wirst.

**Prayer (English).** Rule us also so by the sceptre of thy word and the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we and all men may from day to day submit and yield ourselves more unto thy Majesty; preserve and increase thy Church, and destroy all the works of the devil and all false and wicked counsels devised against thy holy word. Confound thine enemies by the might of thy truth and righteousness, that so all power which exalteth itself against thine honour may from day to day be more destroyed and brought to nought, until the perfection of thy kingdom come, when thou shalt reveal thy glory in us at the last judgement and be all in all for ever.

**R2.4 All estates / households**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Dein will geschehe etc.

**Rubric (English).** Thy will be done, etc.

**Prayer (German).** Verleihe auch, daß wir und alle menschen unserem eignen willen und allen lüsten unsers fleischs absagen und deinem allein guten willen one alles widersprechen gehorchen, daß also jederman sein ampt und beruf so willig und treulich verrichte wie die engel im himmel.

**Prayer (English).** Grant also that we and all men may renounce our own will and all the lusts of our flesh, and obey thy will, which alone is good, without any gainsaying; that so every man may perform his office and calling as willingly and faithfully as the angels in heaven.

**R2.5 Fruits of the earth**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Gib uns heut unser teglich brodt.

**Rubric (English).** Give us this day our daily bread.

**Prayer (German).** Wöllest uns auch mit aller leiblichen notturft versorgen, uns fried und gut regiment verleihen, auf daß wir dardurch erkennen, daß du der einige ursprung alles guten bist und ein getreuer vater, der da sorget für seine kinder, daß auch on deinen segen weder unser sorgen und arbeit noch deine gaben uns gedeien mögen und wir derhalben unser vertrauen von allen creaturen abziehen und allein auf dich setzen.

**Prayer (English).** Provide us also with all bodily necessaries, and vouchsafe us peace and good government, that we may thereby acknowledge that thou art the only fountain of all good and a faithful Father who careth for his children, and that without thy blessing neither our care and labour nor thy gifts can prosper us; and that we may therefore withdraw our trust from all creatures and set it upon thee alone.

**R2.6 Repentance & forgiveness**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Vergib uns unser schuldt etc.

**Rubric (English).** Forgive us our debts, etc.

**Prayer (German).** Wollest auch uns armen sünderen alle unsere missethat und schulden, auch das böß, so uns noch immerdar anhanget, umb des blutvergiessens Jesu Christi willen nicht zurechnen, wie auch wir diß zeugnuß deiner gnaden in unsern hertzen befinden, daß wir unserm nechsten von hertzen verzeihen und sein nutz begeren zu befürdern.

**Prayer (English).** Impute not unto us poor sinners all our misdeeds and debts, nor the evil that yet always cleaveth unto us, for the sake of the shedding of the blood of Jesus Christ; even as we also find this witness of thy grace in our hearts, that we forgive our neighbour from the heart and desire to further his good.

**R2.7 The present congregation**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588. *The rubric is in Kurpfalz 1563 only.*

**Rubric (German).** Füre unß nit in versuchung etc.

**Rubric (English).** Lead us not into temptation, etc.

**Prayer (German).** Und dieweil wir ja auß uns selbst so schwach sein, daß wir nicht einen augenblick bestehen können und darzu unsere abgesagte feind, der teufel, die welt und unser eigen fleisch, nit aufhören, uns anzufechten, so wöllest uns erhalten und stercken durch die kraft deines heiligen geistes, auf daß wir inen mögen festen widerstandt thuen und in diesem geistlichen streit nit underligen, sonder bestendig bleiben, biß daß wir endtlich den sieg vollkomlich erhalten und in deinem reich mit deinem son, unserm herrn und beschirmer Jesu Christo, ewig regieren.

**Prayer (English).** And forasmuch as we of ourselves are so weak that we cannot stand one moment, and moreover our sworn enemies, the devil, the world and our own flesh, cease not to assail us: uphold and strengthen us by the power of thy Holy Spirit, that we may make firm resistance against them and not be overcome in this spiritual warfare, but abide steadfast, until at the last we obtain the victory perfectly and reign for ever in thy kingdom with thy Son, our Lord and protector Jesus Christ.

**R2.8 Conclusion**

*Witnesses:* Kurpfalz 1563 and Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

**Prayer (German).** Welches alles wir von dir bitten, daß dadurch nit wir, sonder du ewig gepriesen werdest, und daß du solches thun kanst als ein almechtiger Gott und thun wilst wie ein getreuer vater, so gwiß als wir dises von hertzen an dich begeren, durch unsern herrn Jesum Christum, Amen. Unser vater etc.

**Prayer (English).** All which we ask of thee, that thereby not we but thou mayest be praised for ever; and that thou canst do this as an almighty God, and wilt do it as a faithful Father, as surely as we desire this of thee from the heart; through our Lord Jesus Christ. Amen. Our Father, etc.

**R2.9 Creed**

*Witnesses:* Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.

**Prayer (German).** Wollest uns auch geben standthafftigkeit und täglichs zunemen in dem alten, waren und ungezweiffelten Christlichen Glauben, auff daß wir uns durch denselben je lenger, je mehr Christi Jesu und aller seiner Güter theilhafftig machen, von welchem Glauben wir bekantnuß thun, mit Munde und Hertzen sprechende: Ich glaub in Gott Vatter, Almächtigen, etc.

**Prayer (English).** Give us also steadfastness and daily increase in the old, true and undoubted Christian faith, that thereby we may make ourselves more and more partakers of Christ Jesus and all his benefits; of which faith we make confession with mouth and heart, saying: I believe in God the Father Almighty, etc.

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## 6.20 Family R3: Calvin’s “grande prière” (Strasbourg/Geneva)

Calvin's Strasbourg/Geneva "grande prière" in Latin, for the French refugee church, ending in a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** Frankfurt 1554 (Poullain).
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** Latin.
- **Form:** continuous prayer ending in a Lord's Prayer paraphrase.
- **Place in the service (Frankfurt 1554 (Poullain)):** Sunday morning: after the hour-long sermon and the announcements (betrothals, baptisms, the poor and sick who commend themselves to the prayers of the Church), while deacons collect alms at the door; followed immediately by the Creed, a psalm and the Aaronic blessing.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1554 | Frankfurt, Liturgia sacra of the stranger congregation (Valérand Poullain) (Reformed) | Frankfurt am Main: French/Walloon refugee church | Sehling 9, VI/Frankfurt Nr. 14, pp. 563–566 | continuous prayer with Lord’s-Prayer paraphrase |

The words between asterisks in R3.8 are said only when the Supper is celebrated.

**Sequence:** R3.1 Special intercessions > R3.2 Exhortation / preface > R3.3 Civil authority > R3.4 Ministers of the Word > R3.5 All men > R3.6 The afflicted > R3.7 The persecuted > R3.8 The present congregation > R3.9 Lord's Prayer > R3.10 Creed.

**R3.1 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (Latin).** Concionem horae spatio absolvit ac subiecta precatione concludit. Admonet autem prius Ecclesiam, si qua sunt digna aut necessaria, Nempe si sponsalia sint, si baptismus, si quis pauper aut aegrotus se commendat precibus ecclesiae et caetera eiusmodi. Interea diaconi duo ad ostium a singulis eleemosynam postulant in pauperum usus.

**Rubric (English).** He endeth the sermon within the space of an hour and concludeth it with the prayer subjoined. But first he admonisheth the Church of aught that is worthy or needful: as, if there be betrothals, if a baptism, if any poor or sick man commend himself to the prayers of the Church, and other things of the kind. Meanwhile two deacons at the door ask alms of every one for the use of the poor.

**R3.2 Exhortation / preface**

**Rubric (Latin).** Oratio

**Rubric (English).** Prayer

**Prayer (Latin).** Deus omnipotens Pater coelestis, tu quidem promisisti exaudire vota nostra, quacunque de re te appellaverimus in nomine dilecti filii tui Iesu Christi Domini nostri. Nos quoque ille sic docuit sanctos coetus inter nos habere in nomine suo, promissis liberalibus etiam invitans, quod his coetibus nostris adfuturus sit medius, quo uno mediatore et intercessore abs te impetremus, quicquid unanimes petierimus super terram. In primis autem iubes nos orare pro omnibus, quoscunque in potestate supra nos esse voluisti, ac deinceps pro iis rebus, quae ad usus necessarios populi tui atque omnium hominum

pertinent. Cui mandato tuo obtemperantes sola fiducia sanctissimi instituti tui ac promissorum tuorum freti huc coram te convenimus in nomen Christi filii tui Domini nostri rogantes ex animo supplices, o Deus idemque Pater optime, in nomine liberatoris unici eiusdemque mediatoris nostri, liberaliter nobis pro tua clementia condones omnia peccata nostraque corda, mentes, cogitatus ac vota omnia sic ad te flectas et pertrahas, qui valeamus te invocare vera et simplici oratione, quae tibi grata sit et accepta.

**Prayer (English).** Almighty God, heavenly Father, thou hast promised to hear our petitions, in whatsoever thing we call upon thee in the name of thy beloved Son Jesus Christ our Lord. He also hath so taught us to hold holy assemblies among us in his name, inviting us moreover with bountiful promises, that he will be in the midst of these our assemblies, that by him our only Mediator and Intercessor we may obtain of thee whatsoever we shall ask with one accord upon earth. And first of all thou commandest us to pray for all whom thou hast willed to be in authority over us, and thereafter for those things that pertain to the needful uses of thy people and of all men. Obeying this thy commandment, and trusting only in thy most holy ordinance and thy promises, we are come together here before thee in the name of Christ thy Son our Lord, humbly beseeching thee from the heart, O God and most good Father, in the name of our only Deliverer and Mediator, that of thy clemency thou wouldest freely pardon us all our sins, and so bend and draw unto thee our hearts, minds, thoughts and all our desires, that we may be able to call upon thee with true and single prayer, which may be pleasing and acceptable unto thee.

**R3.3 Civil authority**

**Prayer (Latin).** Oramus itaque tuam clementiam, o Pater coelestis, pro principibus et hominibus cunctis potestatem gerentibus servis tuis, quibus abs te mandatum est ius dicere populo tuo, nominatim vero pro consulibus et senatu huius civitatis, ut ipsis largiri digneris spiritum tuum, qui vere princeps est et voluntatum moderator, eiusque dona, vim et gratiam in dies magis magisque adaugeas, quo simul vere agnoscant unum ac solum Christum filium tuum Dominum nostrum Regem regum ac principatum tenentem supra omnem potestatem, cui nempe abs te data sit potestas omnis in coelo et in terra, tum certa fide persuasi totis animis studeant vero ac spirituali cultu sese illi approbare regnumque ipsius apud subditos suos provehere et amplificare, quos etiam regant iuxta praescriptum voluntatis tuae ex lege tua, sicuti certo norunt se et illos abs te factos et conditos adeoque oves esse tuorum armentorum, liceat itaque tuo beneficio pace frui, in qua tibi serviamus cum omni sanctitate et honestate liberatique ab inimicis nostris tibi gratias et laudes persolvere queamus.

**Prayer (English).** We pray therefore thy clemency, O heavenly Father, for princes and all men bearing authority, thy servants, to whom it is committed of thee to do justice to thy people, and by name for the consuls and senate of this city: that thou wouldest vouchsafe to bestow upon them thy Spirit, which is truly a princely Spirit and the governor of wills, and increase more and more from day to day his gifts, power and grace; that they may truly acknowledge the one and only Christ thy Son our Lord, the King of kings, holding the principality above all power, to whom indeed all power in heaven and in earth hath been given of thee; and then, being persuaded with sure faith, may study with all their hearts to approve themselves unto him with true and spiritual worship, and to advance and enlarge his kingdom among their subjects, whom also they may rule according to the prescript of thy will out of thy law, as they surely know that both they and these are made and fashioned of thee, and are the sheep of thy flocks. May it be granted us therefore by thy benefit to enjoy peace, wherein we may serve thee in all holiness and honesty, and, being delivered from our enemies, may render thee thanks and praises.

**R3.4 Ministers of the Word**

**Prayer (Latin).** Oramus etiam, Pater verax et liberator unice, pro iis, quos ecclesiae tuae dedisti pastores et salutis animarum procurationem ac sacrosancti evangelii tui ministerium commendasti; eos tuo spiritu sic regas et adiuves, ut sint fideles ministri gloriae tuae, huc studia omnia conferentes, quo palabundus adhuc ovium tuarum grex in unum coeat ad Iesum Christum verum ac summum pastorem principemque episcoporum, uti in eo et per eum in dies magis atque magis crescant cum omni iustitia et sanctimonia vitae. Rursum dignare ecclesias omnes tuas vindicare et eripere e luporum faucibus ac mercenariorum omnium unguibus, qui ambitioni suae serviunt et compendii sui gratia faciunt omnia, nihil minus solliciti, quam ut sacratissimum nomen tuum celebre ac sanctum ubique sit et grex tuus salutem consequatur.

**Prayer (English).** We pray also, O true Father and only Deliverer, for those whom thou hast given as pastors to thy Church, and to whom thou hast committed the care of the salvation of souls and the ministry of thy most holy Gospel: so govern and help them by thy Spirit, that they may be faithful ministers of thy glory, bending all their endeavours to this, that the flock of thy sheep, yet wandering, may gather together into one unto Jesus Christ, the true and chief Shepherd and Prince of bishops, that in him and through him they may grow more and more from day to day in all righteousness and holiness of life. Vouchsafe

again to deliver all thy churches and to snatch them out of the jaws of the wolves and the claws of all hirelings, which serve their own ambition and do all things for their own gain, caring for nothing less than that thy most holy name be everywhere renowned and holy, and thy flock attain unto salvation.

**R3.5 All men**

**Prayer (Latin).** Insuper te rogamus, o Deus clementissime et Pater misericors, pro universo hominum genere, ut qui velis agnosci ab omnibus toto orbe terrarum liberator unicus parta redemptione per Christum filium tuum, digneris etiam, quotquot adhuc hodie ab eodem Christo filio tuo longius absunt, vincti sedentes in tenebris et omni salutis ignoratione, spiritu tuo illustratos per praedicationem evangelii in rectam salutis viam reducere, nempe ut agnoscant te verum Deum et quem misisti Iesum Christum. Quos vero iam eo favore dignatus es, ut eorum mentibus illucesceres manifestatione verbi tui, fac in dies omni bono ac benedictionis tuae spiritualis abundantia auctiores ac beatiores evadant, quo tandem aliquando valeamus omnes unanimi consensu vere et ex animo tuam maiestatem adorare et laudibus extollere ac denique nos totos in clientelam tradere unigenito tuo, quem solum nos agnoscimus Dominum regem ac legislatorem nostrum.

**Prayer (English).** Moreover we beseech thee, O most clement God and merciful Father, for the whole race of men: that as thou wilt be acknowledged of all throughout the whole world as the only Deliverer, redemption having been wrought through Christ thy Son, thou wouldest vouchsafe also to bring back into the right way of salvation, enlightened by thy Spirit through the preaching of the Gospel, all that are yet this day far off from the same Christ thy Son, sitting bound in darkness and in all ignorance of salvation; that they may know thee the true God, and Jesus Christ whom thou hast sent. And them whom thou hast already vouchsafed that favour, that thou hast shone into their minds by the manifestation of thy word, make them from day to day to grow richer and more blessed in all good and in the abundance of thy spiritual blessing; that at the last we may all be able with one accord truly and from the heart to adore thy Majesty and extol it with praises, and finally to deliver ourselves wholly into the keeping of thine Only-begotten, whom alone we acknowledge as our Lord, King and Lawgiver.

**R3.6 The afflicted**

**Prayer (Latin).** Ad haec eos tibi commendamus etiam, o Deus consolator, quos visitas, ut castiges cruce vel quocunque afflictionis genere et populos, quos tu iam peste bellove aut fame urges, singulos denique, quos aliqua per te premit inopia vel carcer aut morbus aut exilium aut quaecunque tandem calamitas, seu corporis illa sit seu animi. Da, ut intelligant tuam erga illos vere paternam benevolentiam, nempe quod ideo castiges et corrigas, ut emendati revertantur ad te ex toto corde suo ac plenam consolationem reportent liberati ab omnibus malis.

**Prayer (English).** To these things we commend unto thee also, O God of comfort, those whom thou visitest, that thou mayest chasten them with the cross or with any kind of affliction; and the peoples whom thou now pressest with pestilence, war or famine; and lastly every one whom any want sent by thee oppresseth, or prison, or sickness, or exile, or any calamity whatsoever, be it of body or of mind. Grant that they may understand thy truly fatherly goodwill toward them, namely that thou chastenest and correctest them to this end, that being amended they may return unto thee with their whole heart, and, being delivered from all evils, may receive full consolation.

**R3.7 The persecuted**

**Prayer (Latin).** Unice vero tibi commendatos volumus fratres nostros electos tuos, quotquot sub tyrannide Antichristi vivunt adhuc dispersi, pabulo vitae spiritualis destituti atque libertate illa filiorum tuorum, ut publice possint nomen tuum invocare, in primis autem eos, qui vincti sunt aut qualicunque modo opprimuntur apud hostes evangelii tui; digneris, o Pater indulgentissime, robur spiritus tui in illis augere, quo firmiores sint nec unquam deficiant, sed constanter perseverent in sancta vocatione tua. Velis illos tuo semper auxilio sustinere ac fulcire, quantum opus esse nosti, simulque consolari in adversis omnibus tuaque cura tueri adversus luporum rabiem, quo per ipsos nomen tuum illustrius fiat tam in vita quam in morte.

**Prayer (English).** But above all we would have commended unto thee our brethren, thine elect, as many as yet live scattered under the tyranny of Antichrist, destitute of the food of spiritual life and of that liberty of thy children, that they might publicly call upon thy name; and first of all those that are in bonds or in any manner oppressed among the enemies of thy Gospel. Vouchsafe, O most indulgent Father, to increase in them the strength of thy Spirit, that they may be the firmer and never fail, but persevere constantly in thy holy calling. Be pleased ever to uphold and stay them with thy help, so far as thou knowest to be

needful, and withal to comfort them in all adversities and defend them by thy care against the rage of the wolves, that through them thy name may be made more glorious both in life and in death.

**R3.8 The present congregation**

**Prayer (Latin).** Da denique, o Deus et Pater, nobis iam collectis in unum in nomine Iesu Christi filii tui ad audiendum verbum evangelii *et communicandum sacrosanctae ipsius coenae mysteriis*, ut vere agnoscamus serioque sentiamus, quam miseri simus ac perditi iam inde a prima nostra origine, in dies magis atque magis iudicium tuum in nos provocantes vitae improbitate, itaque ubi perspexerimus, quam nihil in nobis insit boni quodque nostra caro et sanguis regni tui haereditatem consequi haudquaquam possint, tum animis totis nos ipsos dedamus unice dilecto filio tuo Iesu Christo liberatori nostro unico, ut ita nos possideat et corda nostra inhabitet, quo mortuo ac plane deleto veteri Adamo innovemur in vitae puritatem,

**Prayer (English).** Grant lastly, O God and Father, unto us that are now gathered together in the name of Jesus Christ thy Son to hear the word of the Gospel *and to communicate in the most holy mysteries of his Supper*, that we may truly acknowledge and earnestly feel how wretched and lost we are even from our first origin, provoking thy judgement against us more and more from day to day by the wickedness of our life; and so, when we have perceived how there is no good in us, and that our flesh and blood can in no wise obtain the inheritance of thy kingdom, we may give ourselves up with our whole hearts to thy only beloved Son Jesus Christ, our only Deliverer, that he may so possess us and dwell in our hearts that, the old Adam being dead and utterly done away, we may be renewed unto purity of life:

**R3.9 Lord's Prayer**

**Rubric (Latin).** Paraphrasis dominicae orationis, 1.–6.

**Rubric (English).** Paraphrase of the Lord’s Prayer, 1–6

**Prayer (Latin).** 1. qua nomen tuum, uti par est, supra omnia ubique laudibus extollatur et magnum fiat. 2. Simul etiam ius imperiumque obtineas, imo exerceas etiam in nos omnes, ut magis magisque in dies condiscamus vera obedientia et digna reverentia tuam maiestatem venerari 3. Tuque adeo solus ubique regnes omnium Dominus ac populum tuum sceptro verbi tui et virtute spiritus tui regas et moderere omnesque, qui tibi adversantur, veritatis ac iustitiae tuae potentia debellatos expugnes. Ita fiet, ut potestas omnis atque celsitudo, quae gloriae tuae obluctatur, sensim destruatur funditusque evertatur, donec palam fiat regnum tuum, quod videlicet tu solus rex sis et Dominus, qui ad iudicandum accessurus es. Nos quoque cum creaturis universis tibi per omnia obtemperemus, sicuti novimus Angelos sanctos, qui tecum coelos incolunt, nullum velle aliud habere, quam ut quicquid tibi gratum et placitum fuerit, statim absque remora pro tuae voluntatis arbitrio perficiatur. Nos ita tibi quoque placere studeamus neglectis ac posthabitis cunctis nostrae carnis desideriis et placitis. 4. Donec autem nos coram te ambulamus cum amore et timore nominis tui, tu pro tua bonitate nutrias et pascas omnia sufficiens, quae vitae huic sint necessaria, qui panem nostrum cum pace comedamus, qua tua cura et sollicitudine nostri persuasissimum nobis sit te patrem esse, a quo uno expectanda sint omnia, deposita omni fiducia nostri ac creaturarum omnium, ut in tua unius bonitate ac benevolentia acquiescamus. 5. Quoniam vero, quandiu vita haec manet, nos miseri peccatores in morte media versamur ac fragiles adeo sumus, ut perpetuo prolabamur impingentes ad omnia, semperque aberrantes discedimus a recto, nobis hac in parte sic esto propitius, ut condones haec delicta omnia, quibus iudicio tuo iustissimo nos fecimus obnoxios, eademque condonatione liberes a morte aeterna, cui nostro merito addicti sumus. Ergo malum hoc, quod circumferimus, ne nobis imputes, quemadmodum nos quoque tuo iussu iniuriarum obliviscimur ac vindictae loco bona omnia nostris inimicis precamur. 6. In posterum denique nos tua virtute fulcias, ne rursum carnis infirmitate prolapsi te offendamus. Cumque ea sit nostrarum virium imbecillitas, ut ne ad momentum quidem temporis perstare valeamus atque adeo cincti undique crudelissimis hostibus perpetuam impressionem patiamur a diabolo, mundo et carne, quibuscum nobis continuum est bellum, nos tuo spiritu corrobora et gratiarum tuarum donis munias, ut possimus constanter perstare adversus omne genus tentationis inque spirituali hac lucta sic pergere, ut tandem victoria plena potiti triumphum agamus in regno tuo una cum duce et capite summoque et unico protectore nostro Domino Iesu Christo, Amen.

**Prayer (English).** 1. whereby thy name, as is meet, may be extolled with praises above all things everywhere and be made great. 2. That thou mayest also hold, yea, exercise thy right and dominion over us all, that we may learn more and more from day to day to worship thy Majesty with true obedience and due reverence; 3. and that thou alone mayest reign everywhere, the Lord of all, and govern and rule thy people by the sceptre of thy word and the power of thy Spirit, and overthrow all that oppose thee, vanquished by the might of thy truth and righteousness. So shall it come to pass that all power and height that striveth against thy glory shall little by little be destroyed and utterly overturned, until thy kingdom be made manifest, to wit, that thou alone art

King and Lord, who art to come to judgement. May we also with all creatures obey thee in all things, as we know that the holy Angels, which dwell with thee in the heavens, will have nothing else but that whatsoever is pleasing and acceptable unto thee be forthwith performed without delay according to the pleasure of thy will; and may we so study to please thee also, all the desires and pleasures of our flesh being neglected and set aside. 4. And so long as we walk before thee with love and fear of thy name, do thou of thy goodness nourish and feed us, supplying all things that be necessary for this life, that we may eat our bread in peace, whereby through thy care and solicitude for us we may be most fully persuaded that thou art the Father from whom alone all things are to be looked for, and, laying aside all trust in ourselves and in all creatures, may rest in thy goodness and benevolence alone. 5. But forasmuch as, so long as this life endureth, we miserable sinners are in the midst of death, and are so frail that we continually slip and stumble at all things, and ever wandering depart from the right: be thou in this behalf so propitious unto us, that thou pardon all these offences whereby we have made ourselves liable to thy most just judgement, and by the same pardon deliver us from eternal death, to which by our desert we are adjudged. Therefore impute not unto us this evil that we carry about, even as we also by thy commandment forget injuries, and instead of revenge pray for all good things for our enemies. 6. And finally, for the time to come uphold us by thy power, lest, falling again through the infirmity of the flesh, we offend thee. And since such is the weakness of our strength that we cannot stand firm even for a moment of time, and being beset on every side with most cruel enemies we suffer continual assault from the devil, the world and the flesh, with which we have perpetual war: strengthen us by thy Spirit and fortify us with the gifts of thy graces, that we may stand constantly against every kind of temptation, and so go on in this spiritual combat that at the last, having obtained full victory, we may triumph in thy kingdom together with our Captain and Head and highest and only Protector, the Lord Jesus Christ. Amen.

**R3.10 Creed**

**Rubric (Latin).** Huic precationi immediate symbolum additur, quo recitato praecentor statim psalmum incipit, cui deinde populus accinit ad finem usque, quo decantato pastor populum dimittit hac bona imprecatione.

**Rubric (English).** To this prayer the Creed is immediately added; which being recited, the precentor straightway beginneth a psalm, to which the people then sing to the end; which being sung, the pastor dismisseth the people with this good wish.

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## 6.21 Family R4: à Lasco/Micron (London stranger church)

The London Dutch stranger church's prayer after the sermon (German version for East Frisia), still praying for the King of England and the city of London.

- **Earliest witness (archetype):** London 1554 (à Lasco/Micron).
- **Tradition:** Reformed.
- **Language:** German.
- **Form:** continuous prayer + Our Father.
- **Place in the service (London 1554 (Micron)):** Sunday morning after the sermon, the prayer for the fruit of the Word, the Decalogue, confession, declaration of loosing and binding, and the Creed; then the Our Father, and baptism, the Supper or marriage; a psalm and the blessing with a charge to remember the poor. “Das grosse gebet vor die gemeine notdurft” is said after every sermon.

| Year | Witness | Territory | Sehling | Form |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1554 | London, Dutch stranger church: Marten Micron, Christlicke Ordinancien (1554; German edition 1565) (Reformed) | London Dutch refugee church (edition for East Frisia) | Sehling 7/1, IV/Ostfriesland Nr. 23 (Microns Ordinancien 1554/1565), pp. 603–604 | continuous prayer + Lord’s Prayer |

**Sequence:** R4.1 Thanksgiving > R4.2 The Church > R4.3 Civil authority > R4.4 The present congregation > R4.5 The present congregation > R4.6 The erring & unbelievers > R4.7 The persecuted > R4.8 The afflicted > R4.9 Lord's Prayer > R4.10 Special intercessions.

**R4.1 Thanksgiving**

**Rubric (German).** Nach diser bekäntnuß fahet der diener das gemeine gebet an für allerley not der christlichen gemeine auf dise weise:

**Rubric (English).** After this confession the minister beginneth the common prayer for all manner of need of the Christian congregation after this manner:

**Prayer (German).** O almechtiger, himlischer und barmherziger Vater, nachdem es dir gefallen hat, durch deine unentliche barmherzigkeit uns auß der finsternuß der unwissenheit und der römischen abgötterey zu erlösen und uns under andern die geheimnuß des heiligen evangelions deines lieben Sons zu offenbaren, darfür wir dir von ganzen herzen danken, so bitten wir dich demuttiglich, du wollest uns durch die gnade deines Geistes sterken, daß wir den waren christlichen glauben biß ans ende unsers lebens behalten und unser leben darnach richten mögen.

**Prayer (English).** O almighty, heavenly and merciful Father, forasmuch as it hath pleased thee of thine infinite mercy to deliver us out of the darkness of ignorance and of the Roman idolatry, and, among others, to reveal unto us the mystery of the holy Gospel of thy dear Son, for which we give thee thanks with our whole heart: we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest strengthen us by the grace of thy Spirit, that we may keep the true Christian faith unto the end of our life and order our life thereafter.

**R4.2 The Church**

**Prayer (German).** Wir bitten dich auch, allerheiligster Vater, für die gemeine kirch deines lieben Sohns Jesu Christi, die durch die ganze weite welt zerstreuet ist, in welcher die gottselige lere deines Sohns (nachdem der greuel und abgötterey des römischen antichrists außgerottet ist) geleret und erhalten wird. Wehre von denselbigen alle falsche hirten und lerer und sende gottselige, getreue und ernsthaftige arbeiter in deine ernd, welche nit ihre eigene ehr suchen, sonder allein deine ehre und die erbauung deiner gemeine.

**Prayer (English).** We pray thee also, most holy Father, for the common Church of thy dear Son Jesus Christ, which is scattered throughout the whole wide world, wherein the godly doctrine of thy Son is taught and maintained (the abomination and idolatry of the Roman Antichrist being rooted out). Keep from her all false shepherds and teachers, and send godly, faithful and earnest labourers into thine harvest, which seek not their own honour, but thine honour only and the edifying of thy congregation.

**R4.3 Civil authority**

**Prayer (German).** Und erstlich bitten wir, allergnedigister Vater, für die gemeine dieses reichs Engeland und für alle seine diener und insonderheit für unsern gnedigisten herren könig N. N., wollest ihn behüten und bewaren und mit deinem Geist regieren, auf daß er sein volk unter unserm gemeinem haubt Jesu Christo regieren möge, daß wir ein gerüigs und stilles leben under ihm in aller gottseligkeit und erbarkeit nach deinem wort durch deine gnade füren mögen. Wir bitten auch für der königlichen majestät hoffgesind und den adel, auch für alle herren und oberkeit des ganzen königreichs und vörnemlich für den wollweisen hohen rat königlicher majestet, begabe ihn mit den geist des rats, der sterke und bestendigkeit. Gebe ihnen auch den geist der einigkeit und des friedes, auf daß sie allem dem, das recht und gut ist, in ihrer regierung folgen und also eine christliche ruhe und frieden in disem reich fürdern und erhalten helfen.

**Prayer (English).** And first we pray, most gracious Father, for the congregation of this realm of England and for all its ministers, and especially for our most gracious lord King N. N.: preserve and keep him and govern him with thy Spirit, that he may rule his people under our common Head Jesus Christ, that we may lead under him a quiet and still life in all godliness and honesty according to thy word by thy grace. We pray also for the King's Majesty's household and the nobility, and for all lords and magistrates of the whole kingdom, and chiefly for the right wise high council of the King's Majesty: endue it with the spirit of counsel, of strength and of constancy. Give them also the spirit of unity and of peace, that in their government they may follow all that is right and good, and so help to further and maintain a Christian quiet and peace in this realm.

**R4.4 The present congregation**

**Prayer (German).** Wollest auch das ganze volk dises reichs mit deinem Geist begaben, daß es die stimme deiner propheten willig höre und der lehre deines Sohns Jesu Christi wahr nemme und in derselbigen täglich mehr und mehr zunehme, auch daß es in dem waren gehorsam (denn es der königlichen majestät und dero verordneten schuldig ist) bestendig bleibe, zur wolfart

dises reichs und erbauung der christlichen gemeine. Wir bitten weiter deine göttliche gnade für diese statt Londen, daß du von derselbigen allerley plagen (die wir täglich verdienen) abwenden und sie in aller gottseligkeit, fride und gemeiner ruhe erhalten wollest. Regiere auch die oberkeit derselbigen mit deinem Geist, daß sie in deiner forcht treulich und weißlich ihren dienst versehen möge.

**Prayer (English).** Endue also the whole people of this realm with thy Spirit, that it may willingly hear the voice of thy prophets, and take heed to the doctrine of thy Son Jesus Christ, and increase therein more and more from day to day; and that it may abide constant in the true obedience which it oweth to the King's Majesty and his officers, to the welfare of this realm and the edifying of the Christian congregation. We pray further thy divine grace for this city of London, that thou wouldest turn away from it all manner of plagues (which we daily deserve), and preserve it in all godliness, peace and common quiet. Govern also the magistrates thereof with thy Spirit, that they may perform their office faithfully and wisely in thy fear.

**R4.5 The present congregation**

**Prayer (German).** Insonderheit bitten wir dich, o allergütigster Vater, fur dise unsere frembde gemeine, du wollest deine gunst gegen ihr also, wie du sie durch deine wunderbarliche gnade hieher gepflanzet, hinfur beweisen, daß sie von aller weltlicher tyranney und falschen lere durch deine macht und barmherzigkeit geschützet, täglich je mehr und mehr in aller gottseligkeit und warer einigkeit der herzen zunemen möge.

**Prayer (English).** Especially we pray thee, O most gracious Father, for this our stranger congregation, that thou wouldest henceforth so show thy favour toward her, as thou hast planted her here by thy wonderful grace, that, being defended by thy power and mercy from all worldly tyranny and false doctrine, she may increase daily more and more in all godliness and true unity of hearts.

**R4.6 The erring & unbelievers**

**Prayer (German).** Wir bitten dich auch demütiglich für alle könige, fürsten, oberkeiten und völker, so die stimme deines Sohns (dieweil sie mit der antichristischen abgötterey verblendet sind) noch nit haben erkennen können und die lebendige glieder deines Sohns (den sie nit erkennen) feindlich durch unwissenheit verfolgen, du wollest sie mit allen andern verblenten oder (durch irgenteine schwachheit) verfüreten personen zu dem warhaftigen liecht und rechten wege bringen, auf daß wir alle in einen schaffstal under dem einigen hirten unser seelen Christo Jesu versamlet, dich einmütiglich preisen in ewigkeit.

**Prayer (English).** We pray thee also humbly for all kings, princes, magistrates and peoples which (being blinded with the antichristian idolatry) have not yet been able to know the voice of thy Son, and through ignorance persecute as enemies the living members of thy Son (whom they know not): that thou wouldest bring them, with all other persons blinded or (through any weakness) led astray, to the true light and the right way, that we all, gathered into one sheepfold under the one Shepherd of our souls, Christ Jesus, may praise thee with one mind for ever.

**R4.7 The persecuted**

**Prayer (German).** Zum letzten bitten wir auch für alle unsere mitbrüder, uber den ganzen erdkreiß zerstreuet, welche umb der rechten bekantnuß willen deines Sons und seiner lere durch den antichristen under dem kreuz underdrucket sind, und insonderheit wollest trösten mit deinem heiligen Geist N. N. und ihre herzen mit deiner göttlichen kraft in dem rechten glauben von oben herab also sterken, daß sie alles, so du ihnen zusendest, geduldiglich, menlich und mit danksagung tragen mögen; und daß sie ohne furcht bestendig deinen und deines Sohns namen für den menschen herrlich bekennen und groß machen, es sey durch leben oder sterben, wie du das zu deiner ehren erkennest dienstlich sein.

**Prayer (English).** Lastly we pray also for all our brethren scattered over the whole earth, which for the right confession of thy Son and his doctrine are oppressed under the cross by Antichrist; and especially wilt thou comfort with thy Holy Spirit N. N., and so strengthen their hearts from above with thy divine power in the right faith, that they may bear all that thou sendest them patiently, manfully and with thanksgiving; and that without fear they may steadfastly confess gloriously before men thy name and the name of thy Son and make it great, be it by life or by death, as thou knowest it to serve to thine honour.

**R4.8 The afflicted**

**Prayer (German).** Sonderlich bitten wir auch für alle brüder, die du mit krankheit, armut, gefängnuß, verbannung oder anderm elend des geistes oder leibs billich versuchet und geübet hast, daß du sie in ihrer not nicht verlassen, sonder ihr kreuz nach deiner väterlichen barmherzigkeit linderen wollest oder ihnen sterke und gedult geben, daß sie bestendig tragen alles, was du ihnen nach deinem wolgefallen zusendest, auf daß sie auß ihrer straffe verstehen mögen, daß sie von dir, als ihrem barmherzigen, lieben Vater, probieret werden zur bewärung ihres glaubens und also sich zu dir bekeren.

**Prayer (English).** Especially we pray also for all the brethren whom thou hast justly tried and exercised with sickness, poverty, imprisonment, banishment or other misery of spirit or body, that thou wouldest not forsake them in their need, but mitigate their cross according to thy fatherly mercy, or give them strength and patience to bear steadfastly all that thou sendest them according to thy good pleasure; that they may understand by their chastisement that they are proved of thee, as their merciful, dear Father, for the trial of their faith, and so be converted unto thee.

**R4.9 Lord's Prayer**

**Prayer (German).** Alle dise ding begeren wir von dir, allergnedigister Vater, durch deine väterliche gnad und gunst, die du in deinem Sohne gegen uns bewiesen hast. Und in diser ungezweifelten hoffnung ruffen wir demütiglich deinen namen ahn durch denselbigen deinen geliebten Sohn Jesum Christum, wie wir von ihm gelehret sind, sprechende: Unser Vater, der du bist in den himlen etc.

**Prayer (English).** All these things we desire of thee, most gracious Father, through thy fatherly grace and favour which thou hast shown toward us in thy Son. And in this undoubted hope we humbly call upon thy name through the same thy beloved Son Jesus Christ, as we are taught of him, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc.

**R4.10 Special intercessions**

**Rubric (German).** Hie ist zu merken, daß hie zum oftermal andere gebet zugetan werden, ehe das Vater unser gesprochen wird, insonderheit, wo sonst etwa ein besonder anligen kompt uber die gemeine.

**Rubric (English).** Here it is to be noted that other prayers are oftentimes added here before the Our Father is said, especially when any special concern cometh upon the congregation.

# Chapter 7. The Roman Canon in German Evangelical Masses (1522–1544)

This file gives the offertory and eucharistic rites of the orders in the Sehling corpus that keep pieces of the Roman Canon and of the priest's prayers of the Ordinary, or that put a prayer of their own in the Canon's place. They were found by a search of the whole corpus (§7.1.3) and are printed in order of date.

| § | Order | Sehling | eko.db doc | Pages |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 7.2 | **Nördlingen**, Kaspar Kantz, *Von der Evangelischen Meß*, 1522 (and 1524) | 12, VIII.1 | 369 | 285–288 |
| 7.3 | **Wittenberg**, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, Luther Nr. 4 | 2 | 4–9 |
| 7.4 | **Allstedt**, Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe* and *Ordnung*, 1523/24 (Radical Reformation) | 1, Nr. 46–47 | 51, 52 | 500–501, 504–506 |
| 7.5 | **Strasbourg**, the early German Masses, 1524–1525 (Moderate Reformed) | 20, Straßburg Nr. 3 | 1279 | 120–162 |
| 7.6 | **Worms**, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524 (Moderate Reformed) | 19, III, Nr. 1 | 1066 | 127–129 |
| 7.7 | **Nürnberg**, parish churches 1524; Volprecht 1524; *Form und Ordnung* 1525 | 11, I.5, I.3, I.7 | 249, 247, 251 | 46–47, 41–42, 57 |
| 7.8 | **Nürnberg**, Andreas Döber's *Deutsche Messe*, 1525 (Neues Spital) | 11, I.6 (exhortation: 11, I.5) | 250 (249) | 52–55 (48–49) |
| 7.9 | **Bremen**, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525 | 7, III, Nr. 1 | 2216 | 403–407 |
| 7.10 | **Lippe**, Low German Mass, [1525–1538] | 22, IX, Nr. 1 | 1549 | 565–569 |
| 7.11 | **Schleswig-Holstein**, Low German Mass from Kiel, [after 1526] | 23, A, Nr. 1 | 1576 | 55–57 |
| 7.12 | **Brandenburg** (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3 | 1746 | 67–71 |
| 7.13 | **Calenberg-Göttingen**, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6, III | 2036, 2037 | 813–817 |
| 7.14 | **Pfalz-Neuburg**, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, I.2 | 386 | 64–65, 72–76 |
| 7.15 | **Bugenhagen**: Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544 (and Braunschweig 1528) | 23, A, Nr. 7; 6, I/2; 7, V | 1576, 1972, 2136 | 89–91; 54–58; 852–856 |

Each order is printed from the point where the offertory stood (after the Creed or the sermon) to the dismissal. For Kantz, the Kiel Mass and Bugenhagen, the priest's preparation at the altar is included as well. The original comes first and the English follows. Annotations name the Roman text each piece comes from.

**Related chapters.** The rest of the Mass, and what stood around these texts, is treated elsewhere:

- the order of the Mass as a whole, the families of ordo and the ceremonial at the altar: Chapter 2, §§2.4, 2.11, 2.15;
- the preparation, the confession and absolution, and the exhortation to the communicants, collated across the corpus: Chapter 3, §§3.3–3.5;
- the collects, the abolished secret and the postcommunions: Chapter 5, §§5.5–5.6;
- the Proper Prefaces and the other propers: Chapter 4, §4.8 and Appendix 4.A;
- the hymns at the Sanctus, during the communion and after it: Chapter 8, §§8.12–8.15;
- the intercessions under the Sanctus as a family of the general prayer: Chapter 6, §6.16;
- the lights and the vestments: Chapter 14, §§14.5.4, 14.7;
- the elevation as a mark of the feast: Chapter 12, §12.10.6;
- the ministrants, deacons and subdeacons at the altar: Chapter 16, §16.4.

The German texts and the Roman comparison texts are given as the Conventions describe.

## 7.1 Summary of findings

The orders printed here run from Kantz's Nördlingen Mass of 1522 to Bugenhagen's Hildesheim order of 1544. Between them they show what the first generation of evangelical Masses kept of three things:

- the Roman Canon (*Te igitur* to the doxology *Per ipsum*);
- the prayers of the Ordinary around it: the offertory prayers, the embolism, the priest's prayers before and after communion, and the words of distribution;
- the rites that go with them: elevation, fraction, the Peace.

§7.1.1 summarises the findings in the order of the Mass. §7.1.2 gives the concordance tables. §7.1.3 says how the corpus was searched and which orders were examined but not printed.

### 7.1.1 Findings

**The offertory.**

- **The offertory prayers.** Luther rejected everything that "sounds of oblation" (§7.3.1). No order keeps *Suscipe, sancte Pater*, *Offerimus tibi* or *Suscipe, sancta Trinitas*.
- **What does survive:**
  - **the offertory chant**: Latin in Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12.1); Müntzer's German *Ad te levavi* (§7.4.1; Radical Reformation); a German hymn "for the offertory" in Lippe (§7.10) and Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13.1);
  - **a rubric for preparing the chalice**: Döber (§7.8.1), Volprecht (§7.7.2), Bugenhagen's orders (§7.15.1);
  - **the *Orate fratres*, recast** as a request for prayer: Worms (Moderate Reformed; "mein und ewer gebet", §7.6.1), Kantz and Bremen (§7.2.1, §7.9.2), and Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), where it becomes a bidding on Rom 12:1 to offer "our bodies" (§7.5.1, §7.5.3);
  - ***Veni, sanctificator* replaced** by the Whitsun antiphon *Veni, Sancte Spiritus* and a collect: Kantz (§7.2.2), Bremen, Kiel (§7.11.1);
  - **the Secret's closing *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen***, sung before the Preface dialogue: Müntzer (§7.4.1; Radical Reformation), Lippe (§7.10), Göttingen (§7.13.1).
- **One prayer over the gifts.** Only Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has one: Osiander's prayer "Wir bringen … dise deine gaben" (§7.14.2). It borrows from *Quam oblationem*, *Unde et memores* and *Supplices*, and asks for the Spirit. Sehling's editor, after P. Graff, calls it the first Lutheran order with a kind of epiclesis (Sehling 8, p. 45, n. 12).

**The Preface and Sanctus.**

- **The common Preface in German:** Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen.
- **Proper Prefaces in German:** Müntzer (Radical Reformation; Blessed Virgin, reworded so that God, not Mary, is praised), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; Cross), Lippe (Trinity), Kiel and Göttingen (Easter).
- **Luther's short Preface.** Luther cut the Preface off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* and joined the Verba to it (§7.3.2). The Nürnberg Latin Mass (§7.7.1), Döber (§7.8.2) and Volprecht (§7.7.2) follow him.
- **The Sanctus after the Verba:** Luther, Döber, Volprecht and Pfalz-Neuburg.

**The Canon.**

- **The only continuous Canon is Worms 1524** (Moderate Reformed; §7.6.3–7.6.9). It runs from *Te igitur* to *Supplices te rogamus* in German, abridged:
  - there are no saints in *Communicantes* (only its closing clause), no *Memento* of the dead, no *Nobis quoque* and no *Per ipsum*;
  - the sacrificial nouns become "bread and wine" and "our prayer";
  - emperor and king replace pope and bishop.
- **Elsewhere single Canon prayers survive:**
  - ***Quam oblationem***, recast as a petition that the bread and wine "may become unto us" the body and blood: Kantz (§7.2.4). Bremen changes it to a prayer that "we may firmly believe" this (§7.9.3).

    - ***Unde et memores***, as a thanksgiving "after the elevation": Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed). A later hand wrote the Worms text of the prayer into the Strasbourg manuscript.
- **The Canon's intercession** (the petitions of *Te igitur* and the *Memento*) survives in three ways:
    - **in the Canon's own place after the Sanctus:** Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed); an optional prayer in Döber taken from Strasbourg (§7.8.11); four collects in Brandenburg (§7.12.2); three in Pfalz-Neuburg (§7.14.4); one in Göttingen (§7.13.1);
    - **as one long prayer "anstatt des Canon":** Strasbourg 1525 (§7.5.2; Moderate Reformed);
    - **as the general prayer after the sermon,** which Bugenhagen calls "unse Canon" (§7.15.4).
- **The Canon critique.** The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533, repeated in Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, demands that the offering clauses of the Canon be replaced by "Wir gedenken des opfers deines einigen Sons" (Appendix 7.A). Sehling's register points to this critique under "Embolismus" (11:183, 13:65), because his note there explains the Würzburg embolism's added saints.

**The words of institution.**

- **Scripture or Canon.** Most orders read the Verba from 1 Cor 11 or a harmony of the Gospels. A distinct line keeps the Canon's own *Qui pridie*: *elevatis oculis*, *benedixit*, *novi et aeterni testamenti*, sometimes *mysterium fidei*. The line runs through Kantz, the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Schwarz at Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Bremen, Lippe and Kiel.
- **Where Müntzer's wording travelled.** Müntzer's wording (Radical Reformation) reached Lippe, Kiel and Göttingen's proper Masses through the Erfurt *Kirchenämter* of 1525–26 (§7.10, §7.13).
- **The elevation** is kept by Luther (at the *Benedictus*), Worms (Moderate Reformed), the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed; cup only), Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg. Kantz moves it to the communion ("Secht …"). Schleswig-Holstein 1542 permits it.

**The Our Father and the embolism.**

- ***Praeceptis salutaribus moniti*** is recast in German almost everywhere, e.g. "Last uns beten, wie uns der herr Christus Jesus befohlen hat …".
- **The embolism *Libera nos, quaesumus*.** Luther struck it out. What remains elsewhere:
    - **its conclusion only** ("Durch unsern Herren Jesum … lebt und herrscht"): Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen, Lippe;
    - **its sung ending *Per omnia saecula*** ("Durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit"): Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Lippe;
    - **one line of its body** ("O Herr, erlös uns von allen sichtigen und unsichtigen feinden …"): Döber (p. 54; Sehling: "Rest des Embolismus") and Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed).

**The fraction.**

- **Forbidden.** Luther forbids the fraction and commixture: "nec frangatur hostia nec in calicem misceatur" (§7.3.3). Worms (Moderate Reformed) repeats the prohibition (§7.6.11).
- **Kept in two orders only**, at the Roman place (the close of the embolism, before the Peace), and neither with the commixture:
    - the 1524 edition of Kantz's Mass, "Hie neme der priester das brot und breche es, so vil ers bedarf" (§7.2.5);
    - Müntzer's Allstedt order (Radical Reformation), where the priest "der communicanten halben das sacrament teilet" (§7.4.3).
- **The *Deutsche Messe*** (1526) has no fraction.
- **Reformed breaking of bread.** Every other mention of breaking the bread in the corpus comes from Reformed orders from the 1550s on (à Lasco, the Palatinate, Anhalt, the Upper Palatinate, Hessen-Kassel). There the bread is broken at the distribution on the ground of 1 Cor 10:16 and Acts 2:42. It is a new rite, not a survival.

**The Peace and the *Agnus Dei*.**

- ***Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*** survives widely: Worms (Moderate Reformed), Luther (as a "public absolution"), the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Müntzer (Radical Reformation), Volprecht, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg, Lippe and Göttingen. Kantz moves it into the communion.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is kept in German or Latin by nearly all. Luther has it sung during communion.

**The priest's prayers before communion.**

- **All three kept.** *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti*, *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* and *Perceptio Corporis tui* stay in Latin in Brandenburg (§7.12.5) and Pfalz-Neuburg (§7.14.6). Volprecht has all three in German (§7.7.2).
  - The "Libera nos" in these orders is the petition inside *Fili Dei vivi* ("Libera nos per hoc sacrosanctum corpus et sanguinem tuum"), made plural. It is not the embolism.
- ***Fili Dei vivi* alone** is kept in German by:
  - Kantz and Bremen, abridged. Bremen changes "by this thy holy body and blood" to "by thy bottomless mercy".
  - Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed), prayed by all.
  - Döber and Kiel, said by the people line by line after the priest (§7.8.8, §7.11.3).
- ***Domine, non sum dignus*** appears once, in German, in Kiel (§7.11.3).
- ***Qui dixisti*** becomes the closing collect of the Mass in Göttingen (§7.13.3).

**The words of distribution.**

- **The *custodiat*** (*Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam*) is the most widespread survival. It appears in about thirty orders of the corpus, from Worms (Moderate Reformed) and Volprecht (1524) to 1609:
  - Worms (Moderate Reformed), Döber, Kantz, Bremen, the Nürnberg *Form und Ordnung*, Göttingen and many later orders;
  - most in the wording of the Albertine Saxon Agenda of 1539, "Der leib unsers herrn Jesu Christi, fur dich in tod gegeben, sterke und beware dich im glauben zum ewigen leben";
  - Brandenburg 1540 uses it only for the communion of the sick (Sehling 3, pp. 79–80).
- ***Calicem salutaris accipiam*** (Ps 116:13) survives in Worms (Moderate Reformed), Kantz, Bremen and Volprecht.

**After communion.**

- ***Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum, Domine*.** Luther made these two ablution prayers the postcommunion (§7.3.5). Brandenburg and Pfalz-Neuburg keep them in Latin; Volprecht has both in German; Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) has *Quod ore* as its *complenda*.
- **Roman postcommunions and collects reused:**
  - Döber's *Largire sensibus nostris* (Wednesday in Holy Week). Sehling thought Döber's prayer newly composed; the identification is new here.
  - the Trinity *Proficiat*: Volprecht, Lippe;
  - the collect *Protector in te sperantium*: Kantz.
- **The priest's final *Placeat tibi, sancta Trinitas*** survives in Kantz, the sacrifice turned into "unser lob und danksagung" (§7.2.7).
- **The *Nunc dimittis*** follows communion in Worms (Moderate Reformed), Döber, Kantz and Bremen.

**The priest's preparation and thanksgiving.**

- **Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer** is the evangelical counterpart of the prayers at the foot of the altar (§7.15):
  - in Wolfenbüttel 1543 and Hildesheim 1544, the priest kneels with the sexton and prays the *Pater noster* and the versicles *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra … Adiuva nos, Deus*;
  - in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 he says the *Confiteor* privately and prays for preachers, king and realm.
- **After Mass,** Hildesheim and Schleswig-Holstein have him kneel again and "thank God secretly for himself".

**How the orders are related.**

- **Kantz** → Bremen (a Low German version) and the opening prayers of Kiel.
- **Müntzer** (Radical Reformation) → (Erfurt *Kirchenämter*) → Lippe, Kiel, Göttingen.
- **Strasbourg** (Moderate Reformed) → Worms (Moderate Reformed; the same Mass) and Döber's optional intercession.
- **Luther's *Formula missae*** → the Nürnberg Latin Mass, Döber, Volprecht, Brandenburg.
- **Nürnberg 1533** → the exhortation and Canon critique of Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.
- **Brandenburg 1540** → Calenberg-Göttingen 1542.

### 7.1.2 Concordance tables

One row per order, in date order; the section number is given with each. "—" means absent; *italic* means a rubric only or a permission. "Canon form" of the Verba means the wording of *Qui pridie* (*elevatis oculis*, *benedixit*, *novi et aeterni testamenti*), as against the wording of 1 Cor 11 and the Gospels.

**Table 1. Offertory, Preface, Sanctus**

| Order | Offertory chant | Offertory prayers, *Orate fratres* | The Secret's *Per omnia saecula* | Preface | Sanctus |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kantz 1522 (§7.2) | — | *Orate fratres* recast; *Veni Sancte Spiritus* for *Veni sanctificator* | — | German, common | German, before the Canon |
| Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3) | — | *forbidden* (all "sounds of oblation") | — | Latin, cut at *per Christum*, runs into the Verba | after the Verba |
| Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation) | *Ad te levavi*, German | — ("Wir halten kein opfer") | "durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen" | German, proper (Blessed Virgin, reworded) | German, before |
| Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed) | — | bidding on Rom 12:1 for *Orate fratres*; *lavabo* kept | — | German, proper (Cross); 1525 common; last form none | German, before; last form none |
| Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed) | — | *Orate fratres*, German ("mein und ewer gebet") | — | German, common | German, before |
| Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3) | *omitted* | *omitted* | — | Latin, cut at *per Christum* | Latin, during or after *Qui pridie* |
| Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2) | — | *chalice prepared* | — | German, cut, runs into the Verba | after the Verba |
| Döber 1525 (§7.8) | — | *chalice prepared after the Gradual* | — | German, cut (Luther's form) | German, after the Verba |
| Bremen 1525 (§7.9) | — | as Kantz | — | as Kantz | before |
| Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10) | German hymn | — | "Durch alle ewicheit der ewicheit amen" | German, Trinity | before |
| Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11) | — | Kantz's *Veni* and collect, before the altar | — | German, Easter | (text breaks off) |
| Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) | Latin; German psalm in villages | — | — | Latin, of the day | Latin, four German collects under it |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) | German psalm "anstat des offertorii" | — | "Gott sey preis von ewigkeit zu | German, Easter | Luther's German Sanctus, a |

| Order | Offertory chant | Offertory prayers, *Orate fratres* | The Secret's *Per omnia saecula* | Preface | Sanctus |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | ewigkeit. Amen" | | collect under it |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14) | — | Osiander's prayer over the gifts ("Wir bringen … dise deine gaben") | — | — | after the Verba, three collects under it |
| Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15) | German hymn while bread and wine are prepared | — | — | Latin, on feasts only | Latin or German, on feasts |

**Table 2. The Canon and the words of institution**

| Order | Intercession (*Te igitur*, *Memento*) | Other Canon prayers | Verba | Elevation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kantz 1522 (§7.2) | — | *Quam oblationem* recast | Canon form | moved to the communion ("Secht …") |
| Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3) | — | — | Scriptural | yes, at the *Benedictus* |
| Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation) | — | — | Canon form, with *mysterium fidei* | bread elevated, cup shown |
| Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed) | after the Sanctus, for rulers and the congregation; 1525: long prayer "anstatt des Canon" | "Post elevationem" prayer in the place of *Unde et memores* | Canon-based; *mysterium fidei* added by a later hand; 1525: 1 Cor 11 read as a lesson | cup only; 1525: none |
| Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed) | *Te igitur* and *Memento*, German (emperor and king for pope and bishop) | continuous Canon to *Supplices*: end of *Communicantes*, *Hanc igitur*, *Quam oblationem*, *Unde et memores*, *Supra quae*, *Supplices* | Canon form ("new and everlasting testament") | yes |
| Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3) | — | — | Canon form, Latin, with *mysterium fidei* | bread and cup |
| Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2) | — | — | Scriptural | — |
| Döber 1525 (§7.8) | optional *gemein gebet* (from Strasbourg, Moderate Reformed) | — | German ("in sein heilige hend") | "zeigts dem volk" |
| Bremen 1525 (§7.9) | — | *Quam oblationem* recast as a prayer to believe | Canon form | — |

| Order | Intercession (*Te igitur*, *Memento*) | Other Canon prayers | Verba | Elevation |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10) | — | — | Canon form, with *mysterium fidei* | — |
| Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11) | — | — | Canon form; cup consecrated after the bread is given | — |
| Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) | four collects under the Sanctus | — | Scriptural, sung | yes |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) | collect for the magistrates under the Sanctus | — | Scriptural | — |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14) | three collects under the Sanctus | echoes of *Quam oblationem*, *Unde et memores*, *Supplices* in Osiander's prayer | Scriptural, sung | yes |
| Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15) | general prayer after the sermon ("unse Canon") | — | Scriptural; bread and cup separately | *permitted* (1542) |

**Table 3. From the Our Father to the *Agnus Dei***

| Order | *Praeceptis salutaribus* | Embolism | Fraction | *Pax Domini* | *Agnus Dei* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kantz 1522 (§7.2) | "Laßt uns beten" | conclusion only | *1524 edition only* | at the communion ("Der frid sei mit euch allen") | German, once |
| Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3) | Latin | *forbidden* | *forbidden* | yes, as absolution | during communion |
| Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation) | recast | sung ending *Per omnia* | *yes* ("der communicanten halben") | yes, with response | German |
| Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed) | recast | one-line remnant | — | — | German |
| Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed) | German | conclusion only | *forbidden* | yes, as absolution | German, once |
| Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3) | Latin | — | — | Latin | Latin, during communion; 1525 German |
| Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2) | recast | — | — | German, with response | German, thrice |
| Döber 1525 (§7.8) | recast from Mt 6 | one-line remnant | — | "Der Herr sei mit euch" | German, twice |
| Bremen 1525 (§7.9) | "Lat uns bidden" | conclusion only | — | — | German, once |

| Order | *Praeceptis salutaribus* | Embolism | Fraction | *Pax Domini* | *Agnus Dei* |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10) | recast (Müntzer, Radical Reformation) | conclusion and *Per omnia* | — | yes, with response | German, twice |
| Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11) | — (no Our Father) | — | — | — | — |
| Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) | recast | — | — | yes | Latin, thrice |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) | recast (Brandenburg) | — | — | German, after communion | Decius' hymn, after the thanksgiving |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14) | "Last uns beten!" | — | — | yes | Latin, thrice |
| Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15) | — | — | — | — | German |

**Table 4. Communion and after**

| Order | Priest's prayers before communion | Words of distribution | Ablution prayers (*Quod ore*, *Corpus tuum*) | Postcommunion | Close |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kantz 1522 (§7.2) | *Fili Dei vivi*, German, abridged | *custodiat*, to all; *Calicem salutaris*, plural | — | collect *Protector in te sperantium* | *Nunc dimittis*; *Placeat* in German |
| Luther, *FM* 1523 (§7.3) | *Fili Dei vivi*, *permitted*, plural | *custodiat*, *permitted* | as the postcommunion | *Quod ore sumpsimus* | *Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing |
| Müntzer 1523/24 (§7.4; Radical Reformation) | — | — | — | new | *Benedicamus* |
| Strasbourg 1524–25 (§7.5; Moderate Reformed) | *Fili Dei vivi*, German, prayed by all | 1525: "Gedenckent, glaubent, verkündent …" | *Quod ore*, German | *Quod ore* as *complenda* | Trinitarian blessing |
| Worms 1524 (§7.6; Moderate Reformed) | — | *custodiat*, German; *Calicem salutaris* | echoed in the postcommunion | German, from *Perceptio* and *Corpus tuum* | *Nunc dimittis*; Trinitarian blessing |
| Nürnberg parishes 1524, *Form* 1525 (§7.7.1, §7.7.3) | — | 1525: *custodiat*, German | — | proper *complenda* | 1525: *Benedicamus* |
| Volprecht 1524 (§7.7.2) | *Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, German | *custodiat* (priest); *Calicem salutaris* | both, German | Trinity *Proficiat* | Aaronic blessing; *Benedicamus* |

| Order | Priest's prayers before communion | Words of distribution | Ablution prayers (*Quod ore*, *Corpus tuum*) | Postcommunion | Close |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Döber 1525 (§7.8) | *Fili Dei vivi*, German, said by the people | *custodiat*, German | — | *Largire sensibus nostris* | *Nunc dimittis*; Aaronic and Trinitarian blessing |
| Bremen 1525 (§7.9) | *Fili Dei vivi*, "dorch dijne grondelose barmherticheit" | *custodiat*; *Calicem salutaris* | — | — | *Nunc dimittis*; *Te Deum* |
| Lippe [1525–38] (§7.10) | — | — | — | Trinity *Proficiat* | *Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing |
| Kiel [after 1526] (§7.11) | *Fili Dei vivi*, said by the people; *Domine, non sum dignus* | — | — | a collect | Aaronic blessing |
| Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) | *Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, Latin | "Nim hin und iss …" (*custodiat* only for the sick) | both, Latin | Nürnberg 1533 thanksgiving | — |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) | — | *custodiat*, German | — | Brandenburg thanksgiving | *Qui dixisti* as the final collect; Easter *Benedicamus*; Aaronic blessing |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§7.14) | *Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, Latin | "Nimm hin und iß …" | both, Latin | the same thanksgiving, split in two | *Benedicamus*; Aaronic or other blessings |
| Bugenhagen 1528–44 (§7.15) | — | none: nothing is said at the distribution | — | Luther's "Wy danken dy" | Aaronic blessing; private thanksgiving (1542, 1544) |

### 7.1.3 Method, and orders examined but not printed

The corpus (`eko.db`, all volumes of Sehling) was searched with regular expressions for:

- the priest's prayers *Qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*, *Domine non sum dignus*, *Corpus … custodiat*, *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum*;
- Canon incipits and the Canon form of the Verba ("hub auf seine augen", "neuen und ewigen");
- offertory language and blessing of the gifts;
- the fraction ("breche", "teilet", *frangatur*, *fractio*);
- the embolism;
- Sehling's register entries *Offertorium*, *Kanongebet*, *Messkanon*, *canon missae*, *Epiklese*, *Konsekration* and *Postcommunio*.

Every hit was read in context. The following orders were examined and are not printed:

| Order | Why not printed |
|---|---|
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 (Sehling 1, doc 3) | No Canon or Ordinary prayers (see §7.3.6). |

| Order | Why not printed |
|---|---|
| Homberg, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, doc 2247, pp. 44–45) | Rules only: "Canon ille missarius, et universae orationes, in quibus reperitur sacrificii aut hostiae vox a nemine ultra in hac coena dicatur". Luther's German Mass is prescribed. |
| Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529 / Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535 (Bugenhagen) | Latin Preface and Sanctus on feasts only, otherwise as §7.15. |
| Heilbronn 1530 (Sehling 17, doc 770, pp. 276–277) | Quotes *Te igitur*, *Quam oblationem* and *Supra quae* only to refute them. |
| Transylvania, Honterus, 1543/47 (Sehling 24, docs 1669–1670) | "reiecto canone": Preface, Sanctus, Our Father and Verba, with the Saxon *custodiat* (1547). |
| Corvinus, *Kirchenordnung* 1542 (Sehling 21, doc 1460) | Luther's paraphrase and the Verba. The distribution "Nym hen, edt und gedencke …" is Strasbourg's "Gedenckent, glaubent" type (§7.5.2; Moderate Reformed), not the *custodiat*. |
| Schwäbisch Hall 1543 (Sehling 17, doc 762) and its communion of the sick, 1537 (doc 761) | *Custodiat* only ("Der Leib unsers Herrn Christi bewar dich zum ewigen leben"). |
| Later Upper German orders, e.g. Sehling 16, V, 1560 (doc 742), after Basel 1526 (Reformed) | A prayer before communion that echoes the *Perceptio*: "uf das wir dein Nachtmal uns nit zum gericht empfahen, sonder zu dem ewigen leben". |
| Reformed orders (Kurpfalz from 1563, Anhalt, Hessen-Kassel, à Lasco) | No Canon prayers; the breaking of bread is a new rite (§7.1.1). |

## 7.2 Nördlingen, Kaspar Kantz, *Von der Evangelischen Mesß*, 1522

*Von der Evangelischen Mesß. Mit schönen Christlichen Gebetten vor und nach der empfahung des Sacraments. Durch Caspar Kantz von Nördlingen.* Sehling 12, VIII.1, pp. 285–288 (eko.db doc 369). Sehling's base text is the print of 1522. The apparatus gives the changes of the second edition, *Die rechte evangelische und apostolische Mesß*, 1524 ("II").

This is the earliest German evangelical Mass in the corpus. It is the source of the Bremen Mass of 1525 (§7.9), and its opening prayers reappear in the Kiel Low German Mass (§7.11). The Mass has no offertory. In its place Kantz puts:

- an address and absolution;
- a recast *Orate fratres*;
- the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* antiphon.

Then comes the common Preface and Sanctus. The Canon is cut down to one prayer, a recast *Quam oblationem* that flows into *Qui pridie*. The rubric in front of it says: "Only now does the evangelical Mass begin".

### 7.2.1 Address, absolution and the recast *Orate fratres*

> *Zum ersten soll der priester oder ein anderer ein ermanung tun von dem sacrament oder sunst etwas tröstlichs us dem heiligen evangelio sagen, wie im der Geist Gottes eingibt etc. Darnach mag er die beisitzer mit solchen oder andern worten anreden:* Allerliebsten in Christo! Uf das ir mit frölichem, begirigem herzen entpfahent den zarten fronleichnam und rosenfarbes blut unsers seligmachers Jesu Christi, so demütigent eure herzen gegen Gott, bekennent im eure sünd und gebrechen mit herzlicher begir und sänen nach seiner göttlichen gnad und hilf! So will ich jetzt, euer erwölter priester, euch mitteilen die heiligen absolution und Gott für euch bitten. Der allmechtig, barmherzig Gott vergeb euch euer sünd! Und ich, us bevelch unsers Herren Jesu Christi an statt der heiligen kirchen, sag euch frei, ledig und los aller euer sünden in dem namen des Vaters und Suns und des Heiligen Geists. Amen. Dieweil ich aber auch beschwert bin mit mancherlei gebrechen, so bitten Gott treulich für mich, das ich disen seinen dienst im zu lobe, euch und mir zu trost und heil möge fleißig usrichten und volenden. Psalm 123: Unser hilf soll sein in dem namen des Herren, der himmel und erden erschaffen hat.

*First the priest, or another, shall make an exhortation concerning the sacrament, or else say somewhat comfortable out of the holy Gospel, as the Spirit of God giveth it him, etc. Thereafter he may address them that sit by with such or other words:* Dearly beloved in Christ! That ye may with joyful and desirous hearts receive the tender body and rose-coloured blood of our Saviour Jesus Christ, humble your hearts before God, confess unto him your sins and infirmities with hearty desire, and long after his divine grace and help! So will I now, your chosen priest, impart unto you the holy absolution, and pray God for you. The almighty and merciful God forgive you your sins! And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, in the stead of the holy Church, pronounce you free, quit and loosed of all your sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. But forasmuch as I also am burdened with manifold infirmities, pray God faithfully for me, that I may diligently perform and finish this his service to his praise, to your comfort and mine, and to our salvation. Psalm 123: Our help shall be in the name of the Lord, who hath made heaven and earth.

**Note.**

- **The absolution.** Sehling's note: it is put together from the *Indulgentiam* at the beginning of the Mass and the absolution of private confession.
- **The request for prayer.** "Dieweil ich aber auch beschwert bin … so bitten Gott treulich für mich" is, in Sehling's words, a "free recasting of the *Orate, fratres*". The Roman request is *ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat*. Here the priest asks for help to perform "this his service".
- **The versicle.** *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini* (Ps 124:8, numbered 123 in the Vulgate) belongs to the prayers at the foot of the altar.
- **The 1524 edition** drops the lay minister ("oder ein anderer") and the psalm verse, and heads the absolution "Die absolution".

### 7.2.2 *Veni Sancte Spiritus* and collect (in place of *Veni sanctificator*)

> *Darnach soll der priester niderknien und sagen:* Nu laßt uns beten; sprechend alle heimlich mit mir: Kumm, Heiliger Geist, erfülle die herzen deiner gläubigen und entzind in inen das feur deiner göttlichen liebe, der du durch manigfaltigkeit der zungen die völker der ganzen welt versamlet hast in einigkeit des glaubens. Alleluja. O Herr, allmechtiger Gott, hilf, das bei uns sei und wone dein Heiliger Geist, das er uns erleuchte und lern alle warheit, beschütze und sterke in aller widerwertigkeit, durch Christum, unsern Herren! Amen.

*Thereafter the priest shall kneel down and say:* Now let us pray; say ye all secretly with me: Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful, and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through the diversity of tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the faith. Alleluia. O Lord, almighty God, grant that thy Holy Ghost may be and dwell with us, that he may enlighten us and teach us all truth, and defend and strengthen us in all adversity; through Christ our Lord! Amen.

**Note.**

- **The antiphon.** This is the Whitsun Vigil antiphon *Veni, Sancte Spiritus, reple tuorum corda fidelium*. Sehling notes that the diocese of Augsburg prayed it in the Mass in place of the offertory prayer *Veni, sanctificator*. The rubric keeps the posture of the offertory prayers (kneeling, "heimlich") but has the whole congregation say them.
- **The collect.** This is not a Roman offertory prayer. It resembles the Whitsuntide collect *Adsit nobis, quaesumus, Domine, virtus Spiritus Sancti … et ab omnibus tueatur adversis*, with "lern alle warheit" from John 16:13. The same collect opens the Bremen (§7.9) and Kiel (§7.11) Masses.

### 7.2.3 Preface and Sanctus

> *Prefation oder vorred der meß:* Erhebt euer herzen zu Gott und laßt uns danksagen Gott unserm Herren; denn das ist billich und recht! Ja, warlich ist es billich und recht, auch heilsam, das wir an aller orten und zu aller zeit dir, Herr, heiliger Vater, allmechtiger, ewiger Gott, danksagen durch Christum, unsern Herren, durch welchen alle engel und die himmelischen krefte anbeten, eeren und loben dein herrliche majestat. Mit denselbigen, bitten wir, wöllest zulassen und annemen unsere stimm, das wir dich auch loben und sprechen on ende: *Sanctus:* Heiliger, heiliger, heiliger Herre Gott Sabaoth; voll seind himmel und erd deiner herlichkeit. Osanna in den höchsten! Gebenedeit sei, der da kompt in dem namen des Herren. Glück und heil in den höchsten!

*The Preface, or foreword of the Mass:* Lift up your hearts unto God, and let us give thanks unto God our Lord; for that is meet and right! Yea, verily it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, through whom all angels and the heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy glorious majesty. With the same, we beseech thee, vouchsafe to admit and receive our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: *Sanctus:* Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth; heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest!

**Note.**

- **The dialogue.** It is reduced to the priest's words, with the responses run in: *Sursum corda … Gratias agamus … Dignum et iustum est*.
- **The Preface.** This is the common Preface (*Vere dignum … per Christum Dominum nostrum. Per quem maiestatem tuam laudant Angeli, adorant Dominationes … cum quibus et nostras voces ut admitti iubeas deprecamur*). The ranks of angels are merged into "alle engel und die himmelischen krefte".
- **The Sanctus.** The second *Hosanna* is rendered "Glück und heil" (Ps 118:25, "O Lord, send now prosperity").

#### 7.2.4 *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*

> *Nun hebt sich erst die evangelisch meß an.* O allergütigister Vater, barmherziger, ewiger Gott, hilf, das dises brot und der wein uns werde und sei der warhaftig leib und das unschuldig blut deines allerliebsten Suns, unsers Herren Jesu Christi, welcher an dem tag vor seinem leiden nam das brot in seine heiligen hende, sah auf gen himmel zu dir, seinem allmechtigen Vater, saget dank, segnet und brach das brot und gab es seinen jüngern sprechende: Nemet hin und essent! Das ist mein leib, der für euch geben wirt. Desgleichen nach dem obentmal, nam er den kelch in sein heilige hend, danket, segnet und gab in seinen jüngern und sprach: Nement hin und trinkent alle daraus! Das ist der kelch des neuen und ewigen testaments in meinem blut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirt zu vergebung der sünden. Als oft ir das tut, so tuts in meiner gedechtnis!

*Here beginneth first the evangelical Mass.* O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, grant that this bread and the wine may become and be unto us the true body and the innocent blood of thy most dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ; who on the day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, looked up to heaven unto thee, his almighty Father, gave thanks, blessed, and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. Likewise after the supper he took the cup into his holy hands, gave thanks, blessed, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and drink ye all of it! This is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me!

**Note.**

- **The rubric.** "Nun hebt sich erst die evangelisch meß an": everything before is preparation. The Canon proper begins here, with the one Canon prayer that is kept.
- **The recast *Quam oblationem*.** Sehling calls it "the prayer after the conclusion of the Canon prayer *Quam oblationem*". The Roman text is *Quam oblationem tu, Deus, in omnibus, quaesumus, benedictam, adscriptam, ratam, rationabilem acceptabilemque facere digneris: ut nobis Corpus et Sanguis fiat dilectissimi Filii tui Domini nostri Iesu Christi*. Kantz keeps the petition *ut nobis … fiat* and the superlative *dilectissimi*. He drops the oblation and its five adjectives. The object becomes "dises brot und der wein".
- ***Qui pridie*** keeps *elevatis oculis in caelum ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem* ("sah auf gen himmel zu dir, seinem allmechtigen Vater"), both *benedixit*, and *novi et aeterni testamenti*. It drops *mysterium fidei*.
  - "für euch und für vil" is *pro vobis et pro multis*.
  - "Als oft ir das tut, so tuts in meiner gedechtnis" is *Haec quotiescumque feceritis, in mei memoriam facietis*.
- **The 1524 edition** has "nachtmal" for "obentmal", and "in sein eerwirdigen hende, saget aber dank, segnet ihn" (*venerabiles manus*).

#### 7.2.5 Our Father with the conclusion of the embolism; *Agnus Dei; Fili Dei vivi*

> Laßt uns beten: Vater unser, der du bist im himmel, geheiliget werd dein nam! Zukumm dein reich! Dein will der werd als im himmel und auf der erd! Unser täglich brot gib uns heut und vergib uns unser schuld, als wir vergeben unsern schuldigern! Und für uns nit in versuchung, sonder erlöse uns von übel! Durch unsern Herren Jesum, deinen Sun, welcher

> mit dir und dem Heiligen Geist, ein warer Gott, lebt und herrscht in ewigkeit. Amen. *Agnus Dei:* O du lamb Gottes, der du tregst die sünd der welt, erbarm dich unser und gib uns deinen frid! Amen. *Ein andechtigs gebet vor der entpfahung des sakraments:* O Herr Jesu Christe, du ewigs wort des Vaters, du Heiland der welt, du warer, lebendiger Gott und mensch, erlös uns durch disen deinen heiligen fronleichnam und rosenvarbes blut von allen sünden! Hilf, das wir erfüllen deine gebot zu aller zeit und von dir nit gescheiden werden in ewigkeit! Amen.

Let us pray: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come! Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Through our Lord Jesus, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever. Amen. *Agnus Dei:* O thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us thy peace! Amen. *A devout prayer before the receiving of the sacrament:* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou everlasting Word of the Father, thou Saviour of the world, thou true, living God and man, deliver us by this thy holy body and rose-coloured blood from all sins! Help us that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and never be parted from thee for ever! Amen.

**Note.**

- **The end of the embolism.** As at Worms (§7.6.10; Moderate Reformed), the Our Father runs straight into the conclusion of *Libera nos, quaesumus* ("Per eundem Dominum nostrum Iesum Christum, Filium tuum, qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitate Spiritus Sancti Deus"). The body of the embolism is gone.
- **The fraction, in the 1524 edition only.** The 1524 edition adds the doxology "denn dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herligkeit in ewigkeit. Amen." It then adds a rubric before the conclusion:

  > Hie neme der priester das brot und breche es, so vil ers bedarf, und sprech:

  *Here let the priest take the bread and break it, as much as he needeth, and say:*

  - **Where the rubric falls.** Sehling's note 7 points out that the Roman fraction came at these same words, at the end of the embolism. There the priest broke the host in three and dropped one piece into the chalice. In 1524 the conclusion "Durch unsern Herren …" stands isolated after the doxology's *Amen*, so the breaking marks the old place.
  - **Was it new in 1524?** Sehling judges (notes 7–9) that the 1522 edition did not know the fraction. There the priest shows "ein hostien", any host, while in 1524 he shows "die", the host just broken.
  - **No commixture.** Neither edition drops a piece into the cup.
- **The *Agnus Dei*.** It is sung once, with *dona nobis pacem*.
- ***Fili Dei vivi*.** The prayer before communion is an abridged *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi … libera me per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum ab omnibus iniquitatibus meis et universis malis: et fac me tuis semper inhaerere mandatis, et a te numquam separari permittas*.

  - The opening clause (*qui ex voluntate Patris …*) gives way to a string of titles.
  - The prayer is plural throughout.
  - The 1524 edition heads it "Oratio".

### 7.2.6 Communion, with the *custodiat* and *Calicem salutaris*

> *Nach disem gebet entpfahe der priester das sakrament, ist er anders geschickt darzu, und nem darnach ein hostien in die hand, zeige oder weise die den communicanten und sprech also:* Secht, allerliebsten, das ist warlich der heilig leichnam unsers Herren Jesu Christi, der für euch gelitten hat den bittern tod. Nement hin und essent in, das er euch speis, neer und beware in das ewig leben! Amen. Der frid sei mit euch allen! *So er sie nu alle communiciert hat mit dem heiligen fronleichnam Christi, sprech er also:* Laßt uns auch trinken den kelch des heils und anrufen den namen unsers Herren! *Und wenn er getrunken hat, soll er sich mit dem kelch oder becher zu inen keren und also sprechen:* Secht, das ist warlich der teur schatz des kostbarlichen bluts unsers Herren Jesu Christi, damit ir erkauft seit. Nement hin und teilents miteinander zu abwäschung euer sünden!

*After this prayer let the priest receive the sacrament, if he be otherwise prepared thereto, and then take a host in his hand, show or point it to the communicants, and say thus:* Behold, dearly beloved, this is verily the holy body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which

suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat it, that it may feed, nourish and preserve you unto everlasting life! Amen. Peace be with you all! *When he hath now communicated them all with the holy body of Christ, let him say thus:* Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of our Lord! *And when he hath drunk, he shall turn him to them with the chalice or cup, and say thus:* Behold, this is verily the precious treasure of the costly blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take it, and divide it among you, to the washing away of your sins!

**Note.**

- **"Secht …".** The showing of the host with "Behold" takes the place of the elevation (Sehling: "Die Elevation, die Kantz also vom Konsekrationsakt in die Kommunion verlegt hat"). It also recalls the *Ecce Agnus Dei* of the late-medieval communion of the people.
- **"… das er euch speis, neer und beware in das ewig leben"** is the *custodiat* formula (*Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam*), spoken to all at once.
- **"Der frid sei mit euch allen".** The *Pax Domini* has moved from before the *Agnus Dei* to the communion. The 1524 edition makes it "Der frid sei mit dir!", said to each communicant.
- **"Laßt uns auch trinken den kelch des heils …"** is the priest's *Calicem salutaris accipiam, et nomen Domini invocabo* (Ps 116:13), from his prayers at the sumption. It is turned into a plural invitation.
- **The cup.** "teilents miteinander" echoes Luke 22:17.

### 7.2.7 Thanksgiving: *Nunc dimittis*, *Te Deum*, collects

> *So das geschehen ist, soll der priester niderknien und danksagen:* O Herr, nu laß im frid deine diener nach deinem wort; denn unsere augen haben gesehen dein Heiland, welchen du bereitet hast vor dem angesicht aller völker, ein liecht zu erleüchten die heiden und zu einer glori deins volks Israel. Dir sei lob, eer und dank, o du heilige, gebenedeite, herrliche dreivaltigkeit, Gott Vater, Sun und Heiliger Geist! Amen. *Item zu danksagung mag man sprechen:* Te Deum laudamus. Gott, dich loben wir; dich, Herr, bekennen wir. […] Nunc dimittis servum tuum, Domine, secundum verbum tuum in pace […]. Gloria Patri etc., sicut erat in principio et nunc et semper et in secula seculorum. Amen. O gütiger, barmherziger Got, ein sterk aller, die in dich hoffen, hilf, das wir also wandlen durch das zeitlich, uf das wir nit verlieren das ewig, durch Christum, unsern Herren. Amen. O du heilige dreivaltigkeit, laß dir wolgefallen unser lob und danksagung! Mach vest und stet das werk, das du in uns verbracht[!] hast! Hilf, das uns fruchtbar und fürderlich sei in das ewig leben! Amen.

*When that is done, the priest shall kneel down and give thanks:* O Lord, now lettest thou thy servants depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, a light to lighten the Gentiles, and to be the glory of thy people Israel. Unto thee be praise, honour and thanks, O thou holy, blessed, glorious Trinity, God the Father, Son and Holy Ghost! Amen. *Item, for thanksgiving one may say:* Te Deum laudamus. We praise thee, O God; we acknowledge thee to be the Lord. […] Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace, according to thy word […]. Glory be to the Father, etc., as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen. O gracious and merciful God, the strength of all that hope in thee, help us so to walk through things temporal that we lose not the things eternal; through Christ our Lord. Amen. O thou holy Trinity, let our praise and thanksgiving be well-pleasing unto thee! Make firm and steadfast the work which thou hast wrought in us! Grant that it may be fruitful and profitable unto us unto everlasting life! Amen.

**Note.**

- **The *Nunc dimittis*.** Made plural ("deine diener", "unsere augen"). Sehling notes it was among the priest's silent prayers at this point in some German churches.
- **The first collect.** Sehling identifies it as the collect of the third Sunday after Pentecost, *Protector in te sperantium, Deus … ut sic transeamus per bona temporalia, ut non amittamus aeterna*, not a postcommunion.
- **The Trinity prayer is the *Placeat*.** Sehling thought it "wohl von Kantz geschaffen". It is in fact the priest's last prayer of the Roman Mass, said before the blessing: *Placeat tibi, sancta Trinitas, obsequium servitutis meae: et praesta, ut sacrificium, quod oculis tuae maiestatis indignus obtuli, tibi sit acceptabile, mihique et omnibus, pro quibus illud obtuli, sit, te miserante, propitiabile*.
  - "laß dir wolgefallen unser lob und danksagung" is *placeat tibi … obsequium*.
  - The sacrifice offered becomes "das werk, das du in uns verbracht hast": God's work in us, not ours before him.
  - "fruchtbar und fürderlich … in das ewig leben" takes the place of *propitiabile*.
- **What follows.** The order ends by permitting the Latin *Te Deum* and the Magnificat "for thanksgiving". There is no blessing.

## 7.3 Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523

Sehling 1, Martin Luther's Ordnungen Nr. 4, pp. 4–9 (`eko.db` doc 2; the database dates the document 1889, the year of Sehling's volume). The order is in Latin. It is included because it is the model the German Masses answer to. Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12) takes its Latin communion prayers from the permissions given here. The Nürnberg Latin order of 1524 (§7.7.1) takes its shortened Preface from it.

Luther states the rule first: everything that "sounds of oblation", with the whole Canon, is to go. What is "pure and holy" stays. The paragraphs below are numbered as in the print.

### 7.3.1 The rule, and the preparation of bread and wine

> Octavo, sequitur tota illa abominatio, cui servire coactum est quicquid in missa praecessit, unde et offertorium vocatur. Et abhinc omnia fere sonant ac olent oblationem. […] Proinde omnibus illis repudiatis quae oblationem sonant, cum universo canone, retineamus, quae pura et sancta sunt, ac sic missam nostram ordiamur. I. Sub symbolo vel post canonem apparetur panis et vinum ad benedictionem ritu solito, nisi quod nondum constitui mecum, miscendane sit aqua vino, quamquam huc inclino, ut merum potius vinum paretur absque aquae mixtura […]. Tamen contra libertatem non introducam legem superstitiosam.

Eighthly, there followeth all that abomination, to which everything that went before in the Mass was forced to serve, whence also it is called the offertory. And from here on almost everything soundeth and savoureth of oblation. […] Therefore, all those things being rejected which sound of oblation, together with the whole Canon, let us retain those things which are pure and holy, and so begin our Mass. I. During the Creed, or after the canon [*sermon*], let bread and wine be made ready for the blessing in the accustomed manner; save that I have not yet determined with myself whether water be to be mixed with the wine, though I incline to this, that pure wine rather be prepared without the mixture of water […]. Yet I will not bring in a superstitious law against liberty.

**Note.**

- **"post canonem".** This is Sehling's reading. The Weimar edition (WA 12, 211) reads *post concionem*, "after the sermon". That fits the paragraph before, which lets the vernacular sermon come after the Creed.
- **What goes.** The offertory prayers (*Suscipe, sancte Pater*; *Offerimus tibi*; *Veni, sanctificator*; *Suscipe, sancta Trinitas*), the *Orate fratres*, the Secret and the whole Canon, as all "sounding of oblation".
- **What stays** is set out in §§II–VIII below.

### 7.3.2 Preface, Verba, Sanctus with elevation

> II. Apparato pane et vino mox procedatur ad hunc modum: 'Dominus vobiscum', respon.: 'Et cum spiritu tuo'. 'Sursum corda', respon.: 'Habeamus ad dominum'. 'Gratias agamus domino deo nostro'. Respon.: 'dignum et iustum est. Vere dignum et iustum est, equum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere, domine sancte, pater omnipotens, aeterne deus, per Christum dominum nostrum'. III. Deinde: 'Qui pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem gratias agens, fregit deditque discipulis suis dicens: Accipite, comedite, hoc est corpus meum, quod pro vobis datur. Similiter et calicem, postquam caenavit, dicens: Hic calix est novi testamenti in meo sanguine, qui pro vobis et pro multis effundetur in remissionem peccatorum. Haec quotiescunque feceritis, in mei memoriam faciatis.' Haec verba Christi velim modica post prefationem interposita pausa in eo tono vocis recitari, quo canitur alias oratio dominica in canone, ut a circumstantibus possit audiri, quamquam in his omnibus libertas sit piis mentibus, vel silenter vel palam ea verba recitare. IV. Finita benedictione Chorus cantet Sanctus et sub cantu Benedictus elevetur panis et calix, ritu hactenus servato, vel propter infirmos, qui hac repentina huius insignioris in missa ritus [mutatione] forte offendentur, praesertim ubi per conciones vernaculas docti fuerint, quid ea petatur elevatione.

II. The bread and wine being made ready, let him straightway proceed after this manner: "The Lord be with you"; answer, "And with thy spirit". "Lift up your hearts"; answer, "Let us lift them up unto the Lord". "Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God". Answer: "It is meet and right. It is very meet and right, fitting and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord". III. Then: "Who the day before he suffered took bread, giving thanks, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, eat; this is my body, which is given for you.

Likewise also the cup, after he had supped, saying: This cup is the new testament in my blood, which shall be shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. As oft as ye shall do these things, ye shall do them in remembrance of me." These words of Christ I would have recited, after a short pause interposed after the Preface, in that tone of voice in which the Lord's Prayer is otherwise sung in the Canon, so that they may be heard by them that stand about; although in all these things let godly minds have liberty to recite those words either silently or aloud. IV. The blessing being ended, let the choir sing the Sanctus, and during the singing of the Benedictus let the bread and cup be elevated after the rite hitherto kept, chiefly for the sake of the weak, who might perhaps be offended by a sudden change of this more notable rite in the Mass, especially where they have been taught by sermons in the vulgar tongue what is sought by that elevation.

**Note.**

- **The Preface.** It is cut off after *per Christum Dominum nostrum*. The Verba follow as a relative clause on *Christum* ("Qui pridie …"). This is the form Nürnberg took up in 1524 (§7.7.1) and the German orders of Volprecht (§7.7.2) and Döber (§7.8.2) translated.
- ***Qui pridie*** is reduced to the Gospel and Pauline wording.
  - Gone are *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas*, *elevatis oculis*, *benedixit*, *aeterni* and *mysterium fidei*.
  - "quod pro vobis datur" (Luke 22:19) and "hic calix est novi testamenti in meo sanguine" (1 Cor 11:25) come from Scripture, not the Missal.
- **"benedictio".** Luther calls the recitation of the Verba the "benedictio".
- **The Sanctus and elevation.** The Sanctus, which in the Roman Mass comes before the Canon, is moved after the Verba. The elevation is kept "ritu hactenus servato", during the *Benedictus*.

### 7.3.3 Our Father; no embolism, no fraction; the Peace as absolution

> V. Post haec legatur oratio dominica. Sic: 'Oremus. Preceptis salutaribus moniti etc.' omissa oratione sequenti: 'Libera nos quesumus', cum omnibus signis, quae fieri solent super hostiam et cum hostia super calicem, nec frangatur hostia nec in calicem misceatur. Sed statim post orationem dominicam dicatur: 'Pax domini etc.' quae est publica quaedam absolutio a peccatis communicantium, vox plane evangelica, annuncians remissionem peccatorum, unica illa et dignissima ad mensam domini preparatio, si fide apprehendatur, non secus atque ex ore Christi prolata. Unde vellem eam nunciari verso ad populum vultu, quemadmodum solent episcopi, quod unicum est vestigium episcoporum priscorum in nostris episcopis.

V. After these things let the Lord's Prayer be read, thus: "Let us pray. Taught by wholesome precepts, etc.", the prayer following, "Deliver us, we beseech thee", being omitted, with all the signs that are wont to be made over the host and with the host over the chalice; and let the host not be broken, nor mixed into the chalice. But straightway after the Lord's Prayer let there be said "The peace of the Lord, etc.", which is a kind of public absolution from the sins of the communicants, a voice plainly evangelical, announcing remission of sins, that one and most worthy preparation for the Lord's table, if it be laid hold on by faith, no otherwise than as spoken from the mouth of Christ. Wherefore I would have it announced with the face turned to the people, as bishops are wont to do, which is the only trace of the ancient bishops left in our bishops.

**Note.**

- **The embolism** (*Libera nos, quaesumus, Domine, ab omnibus malis …*) is struck out, with its signs of the cross made over the host and the chalice with a fragment.
- **The fraction and commixture are forbidden.** "nec frangatur hostia nec in calicem misceatur". Worms 1524 (Moderate Reformed) repeats this in German (§7.6.11). Of the evangelical orders in the corpus, only Kantz's second edition (1524, §7.2.5) and Müntzer's Allstedt order (§7.4.2; Radical Reformation) break the bread at this point.
- **The Peace.** *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* is reinterpreted as a public absolution. Worms (Moderate Reformed) and Brandenburg keep it in that sense.

### 7.3.4 Communion: *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *custodiat*

> VI. Deinde communicet tum sese, tum populum, interim cantetur Agnus dei. Quod si orationem illam: 'Domine Ihesu Christe, fili dei vivi, qui ex voluntate patris etc.' ante sumptionem orare voluerit, non male orabit, mutato solum numero singulari in pluralem, 'nostris' et 'nos' pro 'meis' et 'me'. Item et illam: 'Corpus domini etc. custodiat animam meam, vel tuam, in vitam aeternam'. Et 'sanguis domini nostri custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam'.

VI. Then let him communicate first himself, then the people; meanwhile let the Agnus Dei be sung. But if he will pray before the sumption that prayer, "O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, etc.", he shall not pray amiss, only changing the singular number into the plural, "our" and "us" for "my" and "me". Likewise also that other: "The body of the Lord, etc., preserve my soul, or thy soul, unto life eternal". And "The blood of our Lord preserve thy soul unto life eternal".

**Note.**

- **What is permitted.** Of the three prayers before the priest's communion, only *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* is allowed, and it is made plural. *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* and *Perceptio corporis* are not mentioned. Brandenburg 1540 nevertheless kept all three (§7.12.5).
- **The *custodiat*.** It serves both for the priest ("meam") and for each communicant ("tuam").
- **The *Agnus Dei*.** It is sung during communion, not before it.

### 7.3.5 Communion chant; *Quod ore sumpsimus* and *Corpus tuum* for the postcommunion;

*Benedicamus*; blessing

> VII. Si communionem cantare libet, cantetur. Sed loco complendae seu ultimae collectae, quia fere sacrificium sonant, legatur in eodem tono oratio illa: 'Quod ore sumpsimus, domine'. Poterit et illa legi: 'Corpus tuum, domine, quod sumpsimus etc.' mutato numero in pluralem. 'Qui vivis et regnas etc.' 'Dominus vobiscum etc.' Loco 'Ite missa' dicatur: 'Benedicamus domino', adiecto (ubi et quando placet) alleluia in suis melodiis. Vel ex vespertinis 'Benedicamus' mutuentur. VIII. Benedictio solita detur. Vel accipiatur illa Numeri 6. quam ipse dominus digessit, d.: 'Benedicat nos dominus et custodiat nos, ostendat nobis faciem suam et misereatur nostri, convertat dominus faciem suam ad nos et det nobis pacem.' Vel illa psal. 96.: 'Benedicat nos deus deus noster, benedicat nos deus et metuant eum omnes fines terrae. Amen.'

VII. If it please them to sing the communion, let it be sung. But in the place of the complenda or last collect, because they almost all sound of sacrifice, let that prayer be read in the same tone: "What we have taken with our mouth, O Lord". That other also may be read: "Thy body, O Lord, which we have received, etc.", the number being changed into the plural. "Who livest and reignest, etc." "The Lord be with you, etc." In the place of "Ite, missa est" let there be said "Let us bless the Lord", with Alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its own melodies; or let the Benedicamus be borrowed from Vespers. VIII. Let the accustomed blessing be given. Or let that of Numbers 6 be taken, which the Lord himself appointed, saying: "The Lord bless us and keep us, show us his face and have mercy upon us; the Lord turn his face unto us and give us peace." Or that of Psalm 96 [67]: "God, even our own God, bless us; God bless us, and let all the ends of the earth fear him. Amen."

**Note.**

- **The postcommunion.** The variable postcommunions (*complenda*) are rejected because "they almost all sound of sacrifice". The two priest's prayers said at the ablutions take their place, read aloud in the collect tone:
  - *Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus, et de munere temporali fiat nobis remedium sempiternum*;
  - *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsi, et Sanguis, quem potavi, adhaereat visceribus meis* …, made plural.

  Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 kept both in Latin (§7.12.8, §7.14.8). Volprecht (§7.7.2) and Strasbourg (§7.5.1; Moderate Reformed) turned *Quod ore* into German.
- ***Benedicamus Domino*** replaces *Ite, missa est*.
- **The blessing.** Luther's use of Numbers 6 is the origin of the Aaronic blessing at the end of the Lutheran Mass.

### 7.3.6 The *Deutsche Messe* of 1526 (for comparison)

Luther's German Mass (Sehling 1, Nr. 8; doc 3) keeps none of the Canon or of the priest's prayers:

- **In place of the Canon** stands a public paraphrase of the Our Father, with an admonition to the communicants: "Nach der predigt sol folgen eine offentliche paraphrasis des vater unsers und vermanung an die so zum sacrament gehen wollen …".

- **The Verba.** Luther suggested giving the bread straight after the bread-word, "ehe man den kilch segenet", and the cup after the cup-word.
- **The elevation** is kept: "Das aufheben wollen wir nicht abthun sondern behalten, darumb das es fein mit dem deudschen sanctus stimmet …".
- **No fraction, no *Pax*.**
- **The thanksgiving** is a new collect, "Wir dancken dir, almechtiger herre gott, das du uns durch dise heilsame gabe hast erquicket …". Bugenhagen's orders (§7.15) and Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12.8) carry it.

This is why most Lutheran orders after 1526 have no Canon remnants. The orders in this file are those that, like the *Formula missae*, kept something of the old text.

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## 7.4 Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch evangelisch Messe*, 1524, and *Ordnung des teutschen ampts*, 1523/24

- **The Mass.** *Deutsch evangelisch messze, etwan durch die Bebstischen pfaffen im latein zu grossem nachteil des Christen glaubens vor ein opffer gehandelt …* Sehling 1, Nr. 46, pp. 497–503 (`eko.db` doc 51). It gives five Masses (Advent, Christmas, Passion, Easter, Whitsun) with their propers set to the old chant. The ordinary is printed in full with the first, the Advent Mass, on pp. 500–501. It is given here.
- **The commentary.** *Ordnung und berechnunge des teutschen ampts zu Alstadt*, 1523, printed at Allstedt 1524. Sehling 1, Nr. 47, pp. 504–506 (doc 52). It explains the Mass item by item and gives the rubrics the Mass itself lacks.

Müntzer was no Lutheran but a leader of the Radical Reformation; yet his German Mass is the most conservative in the corpus in wording. It keeps:

- the offertory chant, with the Secret's *Per omnia saecula saeculorum*;
- the full proper Preface;
- the Roman *Qui pridie* with *mysterium fidei*;
- the end of the embolism, with the fraction (per the *Ordnung*);
- *Pax Domini*.

His wording was taken over in the Lippe Mass (§7.10), the Kiel Low German Mass (§7.11) and, for the Preface dialogue, Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (§7.13).

### 7.4.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus (Advent)

> O herr, zu dir hab ich erhaben meine sele; o gott, mein gott, auf dich vorlass ich mich und werd nit zu schanden, das mich meine feinde nicht bespotten, durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen. Der herre sei mit euch. Und mit deinem geiste. Unser herzen in die höe. Haben wir zu dem herren. Wir sagen dank dem herren, unserem gotte. Es ist wirdig und ist recht. Warlich, es ist billich und recht und ist heilsam, das wir dir, herr, o heiliger vater, almechtiger, ewiger got, allzeit und allenthalben danksagen. Dann du dein heilige menscheit von der junkfrauen Maria hast empfangen durch die umbschetigung des heilgen geistes, das sie mit unvorruckter keuscheit das ewige licht zur welt gebracht hat, Jesum Christum, unseren herren. Durch wilchen loben die engel dein herligkeit und ehr erbieten die engel, do du innen hirschest; es entsetzten sich die gewaltigen engel; dozu die himmel und der himmel krefte und die heiligen seraphin preisen dich on unterlass mit einmütiger freuden. Drumb bitten wir dich, o herr, das du woltest unsere stimmen mit in zu lassen, das wir dich mit warem bekentnis mügen loben one ende, sagende: Heilger, heilger, heilger herre gott Sabaoth. Himmel und erde seint erfullet mit deinem preise. Ozianna in dem höchsten. Gesegnet sei, der do kumpt im namen des herren. Ozianna in den höchsten.

O Lord, unto thee have I lifted up my soul; O God, my God, in thee I trust, and shall not be put to shame, that mine enemies mock me not; world without end. Amen. The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Our hearts on high. We have them unto the Lord. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is worthy and it is right. Verily it is meet and right and it is wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God. For thou hast received thy holy manhood of the Virgin Mary by the overshadowing of the Holy Ghost, that she with unblemished chastity brought forth unto the world the everlasting light, Jesus Christ our Lord. Through whom the angels praise thy glory, and the angels in whom thou reignest do thee honour; the mighty angels tremble; and the heavens and the powers of the heavens and the holy seraphim praise thee without ceasing with one accord of joy. Therefore we beseech thee, O Lord, that thou wouldest let our

voices be admitted with them, that we may praise thee with true confession without end, saying: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth. Heaven and earth are filled with thy praise. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest.

**Note.**

- **The offertory chant.** "O herr, zu dir hab ich erhaben meine sele …" is the offertory chant of the first Sunday of Advent, *Ad te, Domine, levavi animam meam: Deus meus, in te confido, non erubescam: neque irrideant me inimici mei* (Ps 25:1–2). The *Ordnung* says "Wir halten kein opfer in der geheim gotis": the offertory prayers are gone, but not the chant.
- **"durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen."** This is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, the audible end of the silent Secret, which led into the Preface dialogue. The Secret itself is gone; its last words remain. The same place in Lippe (§7.10) has it as the first words of the "Prefatio", and Göttingen 1542 (§7.13) has "Gott sey preis von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen."
- **The Preface** is the Preface of the Blessed Virgin, not the Advent or Christmas Preface. Its text is *Et te in [festivitate] beatae Mariae semper Virginis collaudare … Quae et Unigenitum tuum Sancti Spiritus obumbratione concepit: et virginitatis gloria permanente, lumen aeternum mundo effudit, Iesum Christum Dominum nostrum. Per quem maiestatem tuam laudant Angeli, adorant Dominationes, tremunt Potestates. Caeli caelorumque Virtutes, ac beata Seraphim, socia exsultatione concelebrant*.
  - Müntzer takes out the praise of Mary. God himself becomes the subject: "du [hast] dein heilige menscheit … empfangen".
  - The Virgin's *virginitatis gloria permanente* becomes "mit unvorruckter keuscheit".
  - The ranks of angels are rendered one by one: *Dominationes* "die engel, do du innen hirschest"; *tremunt Potestates* "es entsetzten sich die gewaltigen engel".
- **"mit warem bekentnis"** is *supplici confessione*.

#### 7.4.2 The Verba, the Our Father, the end of the embolism, the Peace, *Agnus Dei*

> Einen tag zuvorn, do Jesus wolte leiden, nam er das brot in seine heiligen hende und hub auf seine augen in himmel zu dir, gott seinem almechtigen vater, und sagte dir dank und gesegnete es und brach es und gab es seinen jüngern, sagende: Nempt hin und esset darvon. Das ist mein leichnam, der vor euch dargegeben wirt. Des selbigen gleichen, do man gessen hatte, nam er den kelch in seine heiligen wirdigen hende und sagete dir dank und gesegnete den und gab in seinen jüngern, sagende: Nempt hin und trinket all daraus. Dis ist der kilch meines blutes des neuen und ewigen bundes, ein geheimnis des glaubens, der vor euch und vor viel vorgossen wirt in vorgebunge der sunde. So oft ir dis thut, solt ir meiner dobei gedenken. Dorumb last uns alle bitten, wie uns Jesus Christus, der sohn gotes, hat geleret, sagende: Vater unser, der du bist in himmeln, geheiliget werde dein name, zu kum dein reich, dein will geschee als im himmel und auf erden. Unser teglich brot gib uns heute und vorlass uns unsere schulde, wie wir vorlassen unsern schuldigern. Und fur uns nicht in vorsuchunge, sondern erlöse uns von übel. Amen. Durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen. Der fride des herren sei allzeit mit euch. Und mit deinem geist. O lamp gotes, wilchs do tregt die sunde der welt, erbarm dich unser. O lamp gotes, wilchs do tregt die sunde der welt, gib uns deinen fride.

The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat thereof. This is my body, which is given for you. In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and drink ye all thereof. This is the cup of my blood of the new and everlasting covenant, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. Amen. World without end. Amen. The peace of the Lord be alway with you. And with thy spirit. O Lamb of God, which beareth the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, which beareth the sin of the world, give us thy peace.

**Note.**

- **The Verba are the Roman *Qui pridie*, not the Scriptural text.** "Einen tag zuvorn, do Jesus wolte leiden" is *Qui pridie quam pateretur*. The following are all kept:

- *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas* ("in seine heiligen [wirdigen] hende");
- *elevatis oculis in caelum ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem* ("hub auf seine augen in himmel zu dir, gott seinem almechtigen vater");
- *tibi gratias agens* ("sagte dir dank"), still addressed to the Father in the second person;
- *benedixit* ("gesegnete es");
- *Accipite et manducate ex hoc omnes* ("esset darvon");
- *novi et aeterni testamenti* ("des neuen und ewigen bundes");
- ***mysterium fidei*** ("ein geheimnis des glaubens");
- *Haec quotiescumque feceritis, in mei memoriam facietis*.

Only "der vor euch dargegeben wirt" (Luke 22:19) is added. The *Ordnung* (below) has the same text, with crosses at the two blessings.

- **"Dorumb last uns alle bitten, wie uns Jesus Christus … hat geleret, sagende"** is *Oremus: Praeceptis salutaribus moniti, et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere*.
- **"Durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen."** after the Our Father is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, the sung ending of the embolism *Libera nos*. The embolism is gone and its ending stays. The *Ordnung* puts the fraction here (§7.4.3).
- **"Der fride des herren sei allzeit mit euch. Und mit deinem geist"** is *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum. Et cum spiritu tuo*, with the Roman response.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is printed twice in the Mass and three times in the *Ordnung*.

### 7.4.3 The Allstedt *Ordnung* on the Sacrament: Verba, elevation, fraction

> Zum neunten: So singet man die form der termung oder des abentessens im tone der prefation, lauts diser wort folgende: Einen tag zuvorn, do Jesus wolte leiden, nam er das brot in seine heiligen, wirdigen hende, und hub auf seine augen in himmel zu dir, got, seinem almechtigen vater, sagete dir danke und gesegnete ✠ das und brach es, und gab es seinen jugern, sagende: Nemet hin und esset all darvon. *Elevando manu dicit:* Das ist mein leichnam, der vor euch dargegeben wirt. *Vertens se minister, accipiens calicem coram vulgo dicit:* Desselbigen gleichen do man gessen hatte, nam er den kelch in seine heiligen, wirdigen hende, und sagete dir dank, und gesegnete ✠ den und gab in seinen jugern, sagende: Dis ist der kelch meines blutes, des neuen und ewigen testamentes, ein geheim des glaubens, der vor euch und vor viel vorgossen wirt in vorzeihunge der sunde. *Rursus vertens se ad altare dicit:* So oft und dick ir das thut, solt ir meiner darbei gedenken etc. Zum zehenden. Balt nach der elevation singet man im selben ton flux drauf also: Darumb last uns alle bitten, wie uns Jesus Christus, der warhaftig son gotis, hat geleret, sagende: Vater unser, der du bist in himmeln etc.; und alles volk singet drauf: Amen. Darnach wirt es stille, ein wenig, athem zu holen, unter wilcher zeit der priester der communicanten halben das sacrament teilet und singet: Durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. So antwort das gemein volk: Amen. Der priester wider: Der fride des herren sei alzeit mit euch. So antwort das volk: Und mit deinem geist. Bald nach disem, auf das ein geheim gotis, der tod und auferstehung Christi betrachtet werde, das selbe weiter zu erkleren, singet alles volk das gezeugnis Joannis des teufers Christi zu dreimal: O lamb gottes, wilchs du weg nimpst die sunde der welt etc.; do zu singt man aus dem evangelio Luce 17: Erbarme dich unser, und zum letzten: Gib uns deinen fride. […] Auf solchen glauben gibt man dann den leuten das hochwirdigste sacrament unter dem agnus dei, on die bepstische heuchlische beicht.

Ninthly: Then is sung the form of the consecration, or of the supper, in the tone of the Preface, according to these words following: The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy and worthy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, gave thanks unto thee, and blessed ✠ it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take, and eat ye all thereof. *Lifting it up with his hand he saith:* This is my body, which is given for you. *The minister turning, and taking the cup, saith before the people:* In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, and blessed ✠ it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. *Turning again to the altar he saith:* As oft and often as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby, etc. Tenthly. Soon after the elevation one singeth straightway in the same tone thus: Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the true Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc.; and all the people sing thereupon: Amen. Thereafter it becometh still a little

while, to take breath, during which time the priest divideth the sacrament for the sake of the communicants, and singeth: World without end. Then the common people answer: Amen. The priest again: The peace of the Lord be alway with you. Then the people answer: And with thy spirit. Soon after this, that a mystery of God, the death and resurrection of Christ, may be considered, and to explain the same further, all the people sing the witness of John the Baptist of Christ three times: O Lamb of God, which takest away the sin of the world, etc.; thereto is sung out of the Gospel, Luke 17: Have mercy upon us; and at the last: Give us thy peace. […] Upon such faith the people are then given the most worthy sacrament under the Agnus Dei, without the popish hypocritical confession.

**Note.**

- **The fraction.** "unter wilcher zeit der priester der communicanten halben das sacrament teilet und singet: Durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit". This is exactly the Roman place and manner: the priest broke the host during the last words of the embolism and sang *Per omnia saecula saeculorum* over the broken host before the *Pax*.
  - **The reason is new.** The priest breaks "der communicanten halben", for the sake of the communicants, to share the bread. It is not a rite of the Mass for its own sake.
  - **No commixture** is mentioned.
  - Luther had forbidden the fraction in the same year (§7.3.3).
- **"termung".** This is Müntzer's word for the consecration ("die wort der termung"; "die consecration ein termung, wilche nicht allein von einem, sonder durch die ganze vorsamlete gemein geschicht"). Sehling does not gloss it.
- **The elevation.** The bread is elevated at the bread-word ("Elevando manu"). The cup is shown to the people ("coram vulgo").
- **Communion** is given during the *Agnus Dei*, "on die bepstische heuchlische beicht". The *Ordnung* adds that after communion "sagt man got dank uber das volk und gesegnet den herrn etc.": the postcommunion and the *Benedicamus* (§7.4.4).

#### 7.4.4 Postcommunion and *Benedicamus* (Advent Mass)

> O herr gott, steh hart bei uns, das wir von unsern greulichen lastern mügen abzichtung thun, nach dem wir uns durch den geist Christi, deines sohnes, mit dir unwiderruflich vorbunden haben durch dis heilige zeichen seines zarten fleischs und teuren blutes, der mit dir lebet und regiret in einigkeit des heiligen geistes etc. Last uns gesegnen den herren. Gott sei ewiglich dank.

O Lord God, stand hard by us, that we may make renunciation of our grievous vices, forasmuch as we have bound ourselves irrevocably unto thee through the spirit of Christ, thy Son, by this holy sign of his tender flesh and precious blood; who with thee liveth and reigneth in the unity of the Holy Ghost, etc. Let us bless the Lord. Thanks be to God for ever.

**Note.**

- **The postcommunion.** It is not a Roman text. The sacrament as a "heiliges zeichen" of a covenant bond fits Müntzer's teaching. "Zart fleisch und teures blut" are the vocabulary of late-medieval eucharistic devotion (compare Kantz's "zarten fronleichnam und rosenfarbes blut", §7.2.1).
- ***Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*** replaces *Ite, missa est*, as in the *Formula missae*.
- **The Whitsun postcommunion.** The other Masses have their own postcommunions. The Whitsun one ("O herr vorlei uns die gnad des heiligen geists, auf das der thau deiner güte, unsern grund des herzens in seiner besprengung fruchtbar mache", Sehling 1, 504) renders the Roman Whitsun postcommunion *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio: et sui roris intima aspersione fecundet*. Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 took it over (§7.13.4).

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## 7.5 Strasbourg, the early German Masses, 1524–1525

Sehling 20, Straßburg, Nr. 3 "Die frühen Agenden", pp. 120–162 (`eko.db` doc 1279). These are Moderate Reformed orders: Strasbourg's Reformation under Bucer and Capito stood between Wittenberg and Zurich until the Interim. Sehling prints six forms:

| | Form | Pages |
|---|---|---|
| a | Theobald (Diebold) Schwarz's manuscript agenda, "Anfang der evangelischen meß", 1524 | 120–123 |

| | Form | Pages |
|---|---|---|
| b | *Teutsche Meß und Tauff, wie sye yetzund zu Straßburg gehalten werden*, 1524 | 130–134 |
| c | *Ordenung und inhalt Teutscher Mess*, Augsburg reprint, 1524 | 135 |
| d | *Teutsch Kirchenampt mit lobgsengen*, 1524/25 | 136–141 |
| e | *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal, so man die mesß nennet*, 1525 | 142–150 |
| f | *Straßburger kirchen ampt*, 1525 | 151–162 |

The Worms Mass (§7.6) is the Strasbourg Mass of 1524 in use at Worms. Its Canon prayers (*Te igitur* to *Supplices*) are not in Schwarz's text. A later hand added one of them, the *Unde et memores*, to the manuscript, along with *mysterium fidei* (noted in §7.5.1). Döber took his optional intercession from Strasbourg (§7.8.11).

Across these six forms the Canon is replaced step by step:

- **a–d:** a single intercession in the place of *Te igitur*, with the Verba and a short prayer after the elevation.
- **e (1525):** one long prayer "anstatt des Canon" after a shortened common Preface and Sanctus. The Verba are read afterwards as a lesson, and there is no elevation.
- **f:** the same prayer, revised, with no Preface or Sanctus at all.

### 7.5.1 Schwarz's Mass, 1524 (form a)

> *Ad populum versus dicat:* Lieben brüder und schwestern, bitten Gott, den vatter, durch unsern hernn Jesum Christum, das er uns den heiligen geist, den tröster, zuschicke, das er mache unser leib zu eim lebendigen, heiligen, wolgefalligen opfer, das do ist der vernunfftig gotts dienst, der Gott gefelt. Das beschehe uns allen, Amen. *Versus populum adhuc stans dicat:* Der herr sey mit euch. *Prefatio* Erhebt euwere hertzenn. Sagen danck dem herren, unserem Gott. Es geburt sich furwor und ist billich, recht und heilsam, das wir dir alweg an allen orten danck sagen. O herr, heiliger, almechtiger vatter, ewiger Gott, der du unser heil durch das holtz des creutzs verschafft hast, uff das das leben von solchem keme, von welchem der todt uffgangen ist, und uff das der feyndt, so durch das holtz übertrettung uns alle in Adam überwunden hatt, wider uß gehorsam, so am holtz geleistet ist, bestritten wurde, durch Christum Jesum, unsern hern, durch welches maiestat und herlichkeyt dich die engel und alle hymmelsche ritterschafft loben, mit glichem frolocken samenthafft ryemen und preysen, zu welchen du auch unsere stymmen annemen wöllest, bitten wir mit undertheniger bekantnuß und sagen: *Sanctus* Sanctus. Heiliger, heiliger herr, Gott der herscharen, voll synd die hymmel und erden von deiner herlichkeyt. Ach, mach uns selig in der höhe. *Benedictus* Er ist zu loben, der do kumpt im namen des herren. Ach, selige uns in der höhe.

*Turned toward the people let him say:* Dear brethren and sisters, pray God the Father, through our Lord Jesus Christ, that he send us the Holy Ghost, the Comforter, that he may make our bodies a living, holy, well-pleasing sacrifice, which is the reasonable service of God that pleaseth God. May this befall us all, Amen. *Toward the people, still standing, let him say:* The Lord be with you. *The Preface* Lift up your hearts. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It becometh us truly, and is meet, right and wholesome, that we should alway and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy, almighty Father, everlasting God, who hast wrought our salvation through the wood of the cross, that life might come from thence whence death arose, and that the enemy who by the transgression of the tree had overcome us all in Adam might be vanquished again by the obedience rendered on the tree; through Christ Jesus our Lord, through whose majesty and glory the angels and all the heavenly host praise thee, and together with like exultation extol and magnify thee; with whom we pray thee to receive our voices also, with humble confession, saying: *Sanctus* Sanctus. Holy, holy Lord, God of hosts, the heavens and earth are full of thy glory. Ah, save us in the highest. *Benedictus* Praised be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Ah, save us in the highest.

**Note.**

- **The bidding replaces the *Orate fratres*.** The Roman request that "my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable" becomes a prayer for the Spirit, who makes "our bodies" the sacrifice (Rom 12:1). The only sacrifice named is that of the worshippers.
- **The Preface** is the Preface of the Cross (Passiontide): *qui salutem humani generis in ligno Crucis constituisti: ut unde mors oriebatur, inde vita resurgeret: et qui in ligno vincebat, in ligno quoque vinceretur: per Christum Dominum nostrum. Per*

*quem maiestatem tuam laudant Angeli* …. Form b prints further proper Prefaces (Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun) "for when thou hast read … Ewiger Gott".

- **The Sanctus.** "Ach, mach uns selig" and "Ach, selige uns" translate *Hosanna*.

> *Laventur manus. Tacite. Deinde stans per modum orantis: Levatis, si placet, manibus:* Almechtiger, barmhertziger vatter, die weil dein sun, unser herr Jesus, zugesagt hatt, was wir bitten in synem namen, das werdest du uns geweren, und zu dem, dyweil dein geist auch bevolhen hatt, das wir fur unser oberkeyt bitten sollen, bitten wir von hertzen, du wollest die gemütter des keysers, der fursten und herren, vorab unser hern und öberen eins ersamen raths, zu erkantnuß dyner guthe und des evangelions bewegen, auch das du deynem sun durch den heiligen geist underthenig machest alle volcker, uff das sie selbs willigk seyn verheissung erkennen, annemen und behutten. Und vor ab disser gemeyn verleyhe, das sie zuneme in erkantnuß des evangelions und seynes sussen jochs und gemachsamen burden. Dyweyl nun, almechtiger, ewiger Gott, geliebter und barmhertziger vatter, Welcher am nechsten tag vor seym lyden das brott nam in sein heilige hend und dir, Gott, seynem hymmelschen vatter, dancksaget, segnets, brachs und gabs seynen jungern und sprach: Nemmet hien und essend. Das ist meyn lyb, der fur euch geben wurt. *Ad calicem:* Des glichen noch dem nachtmal nam er den kelch in sein heilige hende und danckt und sprach: Nement hien und trinckent alle daruß. Das ist der kelch meins bluts, des neuwen und ewigen testaments, das fur euch und vil vergossen wurt zu vergebung der sunden. *Elevatio calicis:* Als offt ir das thunt, so thut es in meyner gedechtnuß.

*Let the hands be washed. Silently. Then standing in the manner of one praying: With hands lifted up, if it please:* Almighty, merciful Father, forasmuch as thy Son, our Lord Jesus, hath promised that whatsoever we ask in his name thou wilt grant us; and moreover, forasmuch as thy Spirit also hath commanded that we should pray for our rulers: we pray thee from our hearts that thou wouldest move the minds of the emperor, the princes and lords, and first of all of our lords and superiors of the honourable Council, to the knowledge of thy goodness and of the Gospel; and also that thou wouldest make all peoples subject to thy Son through the Holy Ghost, that they themselves may willingly know, receive and keep his promise. And above all grant unto this congregation that it may increase in the knowledge of the Gospel and of his sweet yoke and easy burden. Forasmuch now, almighty, everlasting God, beloved and merciful Father, — Who on the next day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, and gave thanks unto thee, God, his heavenly Father, blessed it, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and eat. This is my body, which shall be given for you. *At the cup:* Likewise after the supper he took the cup into his holy hands, and gave thanks, and said: Take, and drink ye all thereof. This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, which shall be shed for you and many for the forgiveness of sins. *The elevation of the cup:* As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me.

**Note.**

- **The *lavabo*.** "Laventur manus. Tacite" keeps the priest's washing of hands from the offertory, moved to after the Sanctus.
- **The posture.** "Levatis … manibus", "per modum orantis": the priest stands with raised hands, as for the Canon.
- **The intercession replaces *Te igitur*.** It stands where *Te igitur* stood, and like *Te igitur* it prays for the Church and its rulers, with emperor and council in place of pope and bishop.
  - It breaks off at "Dyweyl nun, almechtiger, ewiger Gott, geliebter und barmhertziger vatter," and the relative "Welcher" of *Qui pridie* follows. The sentence is left unfinished in the manuscript. A second hand added a continuation (Sehling's apparatus q, later struck out): "O aller gnedigster vatter, dein einiger sun … welche du der welt geben hast durch Christum Jesum, unsern herren." This is the germ of the long 1525 prayer (§7.5.2).
  - Döber prints the same intercession as an option "nach der prefation oder für das Sanctus" (§7.8.11). Form d calls it "Almechtiger, barmhertziger vatter, Dieweil dein sun …".
- ***Qui pridie*** keeps "am nechsten tag vor seym lyden" (*pridie quam pateretur*), "segnets" (*benedixit*) and *novi et aeterni testamenti*.
  - It adds "der fur euch geben wurt" (1 Cor 11:24).
  - A later hand adds after the cup-word "Die heimlikeit des gloubens", *mysterium fidei*.
  - The bread is not elevated. The cup is elevated at *Haec quotiescumque*.
- **Form b's rubrics.** Form b marks this passage "Anfang der rechten, woren mess" and, after it, "Ende der mess oder des nachtmals Christi, dann vor- und nachgeende wort seind alle zuo bewegung und zuo erfrischen den glauben und nit als hauptstuck der mess ingefürt". That is: only the Verba are the Mass. All that stands before and after is there to move and refresh faith, and may be changed or left out.

> *Post elevationem* Wie groß ist dein güthe, das du uns on allen unsern verdienst die sund nit allein verzigen hast, sonder uns zu einer versicherung verlossen den leib und blut unsers herren Jesu Christi under dem brot und weyn. Wie dan sonst alle andere verheissungen du alwegen mit eusserlichen zeichen betzeugt hast. Darumb haben wir itzundt grosse, unwidertreibliche sicherheyt deiner gnaden und wissen, das wir dein kinder sind, dein erben und miterben Christi, und mögen frey betten, wie uns dein eingeborner sun gelernet hat, und sagen: Vatter unser, der du bist in dem hymelen, geheiliget werd dein nam. Zu kum dein rych. Dein wil geschehe, als im hymmel und uff erden. Unser teglich brot gib uns heut. Und vergib uns unsere schuld, also und wir vergeben unsern schuldigern. Und nit infure uns in versuchung, sonder erlöse uns vom ubel, Amen. Herr, erlöße uns von allen sichtbaren und unsichtbaren feinden, von dem teuffel, der welt, vor unserm eignen fleisch, durch Christum Jesum, unsern hern, Amen. *Agnus dei* Du lemblin Gottes, der du hiennymbst die sund der welt, erbarm dich unser. Du lemblin Gottes, verlyhe uns den friden.

*After the elevation* How great is thy goodness, that without any merit of ours thou hast not only forgiven us our sins, but hast left us for an assurance the body and blood of our Lord Jesus Christ under the bread and wine; as thou hast alway witnessed all other promises besides with outward signs. Therefore have we now great and irresistible assurance of thy grace, and know that we are thy children, thine heirs and joint-heirs with Christ, and may freely pray, as thine only-begotten Son hath taught us, and say: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so on earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, even as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, Amen. Lord, deliver us from all enemies visible and invisible, from the devil, the world, and from our own flesh; through Christ Jesus our Lord, Amen. *Agnus Dei* Thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. Thou Lamb of God, grant us peace.

**Note.**

- **"Post elevationem".** The prayer stands where *Unde et memores* stood, after the consecration. It thanks God for the body and blood left "under the bread and wine" as a pledge, and leads into the Our Father like *Praeceptis salutaribus* ("mögen frey betten" is *audemus dicere*).
- **The later hand at Strasbourg.** At this point it wrote into the margin the German *Unde et memores* that Worms prints: "Des halben, here, wier, dine diener, bedrachten des selbigen dines sünes … liden und sterben, ufferstendnis von der helle und auch die erlich uffart zu den himlen diner götlichen maiestat, da mit anbietten unser diemiettiges gebet, daruf du mit genaedigen heitteren augen schauen …" (compare §7.6.8).
  - It also corrected "den leib und blut" to "die gedechtniß des leibs und blut", and "under" to "in".
  - It added the doxology to the Our Father.
- **The embolism.** "Herr, erlöße uns von allen sichtbaren und unsichtbaren feinden …" is the embolism reduced to one line. Döber has the same line (§7.8.5), and Sehling calls it there "Rest des Embolismus". There is no fraction.

> *Adhortatio ad populum brevis. Communicatio* Laßt unß bitten: Herr Jesu Christe, du sun des lebendigen Gotts, der du uß vetterlichem willen und mitwürckung des heiligen geists durch dein todt die welt zum leben bracht hast, erlöße uns durch dißen deinen heyligen leib und blut von allen unsern ungerechtigkeiten und boßheyten und verlyhe, das wir alweg gehorsamen deinen gebotten und von dir nyemer ewigklich abgesundert werden, Amen. *Complenda* Laßt uns bitten: Das wir mit mund haben zu uns genomen, verlyhe uns, herr, uff das wir dasselbig mit reynem gemüt annemen, und das uns von der zeytlichen goben werde eyne ewige artzenyg, durch Christum Jesum, unsern herrn, Amen. *Vel aliam aliquam, que Christiana videtur. Ad populum:* Der herr sey mit euch. *Benedictio* Der segen Gott, des vatters ✠ und des suns ✠ und des heiligen geists ✠, sey mit uns und bleib alweg, Amen.

*A short exhortation to the people. The communion* Let us pray: Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the Father's will and the working of the Holy Ghost hast through thy death brought the world to life: deliver us by this thy holy body and blood from all our iniquities and wickednesses, and grant that we may alway obey thy commandments, and never for ever be separated from thee, Amen. *The complenda* Let us pray: What we have taken to us with the mouth, grant us, Lord, that we may receive the same with a pure mind, and that of the temporal gift there may be made unto us an everlasting medicine; through Christ Jesus our Lord, Amen. *Or some other which seemeth Christian. To the people:* The Lord be with you. *The blessing* The blessing of God, the Father ✠ and the Son ✠ and the Holy Ghost ✠, be with us and remain alway, Amen.

**Note.**

- ***Fili Dei vivi*** is said aloud as the prayer of all ("Laßt unß bitten") before the communion. Form b adds the rubric "Hie teylt man auß dem volck … beyde sacrament, den leyb und bluot des herrn under brot und weyn". Döber (§7.8.8) and the Kiel

Mass (§7.11) have the same German text, said by the people after the priest.
- **The *complenda*** is *Quod ore sumpsimus* in full. It is the "complenda" Luther had recommended (§7.3.5).
- **The blessing** keeps three crosses.
- **Form d** (the *Kirchenampt*) adds after the *Agnus* a rubric for the exhortation: "darinn sy allein tringen uff die fruchtbar gedechtnuß und heilsam verkündung des tods Christi". At the distribution the priest says "alleyn die wort des nachtmals". Luther's "Gott sei gelobet" follows as the communion hymn, then the Aaronic blessing. The *complenda* is gone.

### 7.5.2 The *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525 (form e): the prayer "anstatt des Canon"

> *Darnach bereit der diener den kelch und spricht dann zu dem Volck:* Liebe brüder und schwestern, bitten alle Gott, unsern vatter, das er uns sende seinen heylgen geist, der uns lere uff opfferen die opffer Gottes, ein zerbrochnen geist und zerschlagen hertz, und daß wir unsere leib zum opffer geben, das da lebendig, heylig und ym wolgefellig ist, welches unser vernunfftiger gottsdienst ist, damit wir Got auch danck sagen und preiß uff opfferen, und er uns zeig sein heyl. Der herr wil eüch alle erhören. So laßt uns nun uffheben unsere hertzen zu dem herren und danck sagen ym, unserm herren und Got. Dann es ist ye recht, billich und heilsam, das wir dir allzeyt und allenthalben lob und danck sagen. Heylger herr, allmechtiger vatter, ewiger gott, Und das durch Jesum Christum, unsern heyland, durch welchen dich auch die engel loben und alle hymlische krefft preisen, mit welchen wir auch bitten und flehen, wellest auch unser stymmen zu lassen, die wir mit demütiger verjechung sprechen: *Sanctus* Heylig, heylig, heylig bistu, der herr und Gott der herscharen, Vol sind himel und erden deiner herrlichkeit. Hosianna, hilff uns, aller höchster. Gebenedeyt bist du auch, der du kumpst in dem namen des herren, ein sun David. Hosianna, ach hilff uns, aller höchster, das dein reich zu nemm und werd gesterckt.

*Thereafter the minister prepareth the chalice, and then speaketh to the people:* Dear brethren and sisters, pray ye all God our Father that he send us his Holy Ghost, who may teach us to offer up the sacrifices of God, a broken spirit and a contrite heart; and that we give our bodies a sacrifice, living, holy and well-pleasing unto him, which is our reasonable service; that we may also offer up thanks and praise unto God, and he may show us his salvation. The Lord will hear you all. So let us now lift up our hearts unto the Lord, and give thanks unto him, our Lord and God. For it is indeed right, meet and wholesome that we should at all times and in all places give praise and thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, and that through Jesus Christ our Saviour, through whom the angels also praise thee and all the heavenly powers magnify thee; with whom we also pray and beseech thee that thou wouldest admit our voices also, who with humble confession say: *Sanctus* Holy, holy, holy art thou, the Lord and God of hosts; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna, help us, most Highest. Blessed art thou also, that comest in the name of the Lord, a son of David. Hosanna, ah help us, most Highest, that thy kingdom may increase and be strengthened.

**Note.**

- **The bidding** is expanded with Ps 51:17 ("die opffer Gottes, ein zerbrochnen geist") and Heb 13:15 ("danck sagen und preiß uff opfferen"). The *Orate fratres* has become a prayer to offer the sacrifices Scripture allows.
- **The Preface** is the common Preface, reduced to its frame. The dialogue is folded into one sentence spoken by the minister.

> *Und anstatt des Canon braucht man diß nachgend gebett:* Allmechtiger Gott und vatter unsers heylands Jesu Christi, der du uns durch den selbigen allerliebsten sun, unsern herren, verheissen hast, was wir dich bitten in seinem namen, wöllest uns geweren, und aber durch deinen heyligen geist bevolhen hast, zu bitten für alle oberkeit und alle menschen, So bitten wir dich von hertzen, durch den selbigen, deinen allerliebsten sun, unsern heylandt, du wöllest das hertz aller fürsten und herren und sunderlichen unser oberkeit, eins ersamen raths, erleüchten mit erkantnüß deines heyligen Evangelii, uff das sy dich für iren rechten, einigen oberherren erkennen und uns, werck deiner hend und schefflin deiner weyd, nach deinem willen und gefallen regieren. Und allen menschen wöllestu verleyhen, zu erkantnüß deiner warheit zu kummen, Und diser deiner gemein, hye zu gegen in deinem namen versamlet seind, deinen heyligen geist, den tröster, der dein gsatz in unsere hertzen schreibt, damit hyn genommen werd unsere angeborne blintheit und thumkeit, durch die wir unser sünd und übel nit allein nit mögen erkennen, sunder gefallen uns selbs wol darin. Darumb, o barmhertziger Gott, aller liebster, mach in uns durch deinen heyligen geyst unsere sünd lebendig, uff das wir ir enpfinden und ire schnödigkeit und schand erkennen mögen, Und dahär, sint dem mal wir in uns selber nichts dann sünd, todt und hell befinden, zu deiner gnad und barmhertzigkeit woren hunger und durst überkummen, damit wir doch zum teil bedencken mögen, mit recht gschaffnem glauben annemen unnd mitt ewiger danckbarkeit preysen deine

> überschwenckliche, unermeßliche gnad und güte, die du uns in dem bewysen hast, das du deinen eingebornen sun hast wöllen mensch (das ist, uns armen sündern gleich) werden, für uns leiden und sterben und durch seinen todt uns von sünden, todt und hell erlösen. So gib uns nun, himlischer vatter, das wir dises todts, durch welchen wir von allem übel zum ewigen leben erlößt sind, Heylsame gedechtnüß nimmer auß hertzen lassen, damitt auch wir mit ym, unserm heylandt, den sünden absterben, zu leben der gerechtigkeit, in aller gedult und lieb gegen dem nechsten, mitt frölicher warnung, Harrende auff die selige hoffnung unnd zukunfft des selbigen, unsers lieben Herren unnd erlösers. Und verlyhe, das wir uff dißmal auch zu solcher heilsamer, nottiger gedechtnüß sein heyligs nachtmal halten mögen mit solchem hertzen, das wir nitt das zeytlich noch unsers söchen, dann den auffgang deyn reychs, beger der sünden loß unnd zu aller frumkeit gefürdert zu werden, Damit unser keiner schuldig werd an dem leib noch blut unsers heylandts Jhesu Christi, noch ym selb das gericht noch verdamnüß niesse, Wo er sich hye bekant, ein glidt Christi zu syn, und glauben, daß er allein durch das opffer, so er einmal für uns am creütz dir, o vatter, uff geopffert hat sein leib und blut, und aber solcher glaub, der durch die lieb gegen meniglich tätig ist, nit hett, und tryb also so vil an ym das gespöt mit dem nachtmal unsers herren, sunder das wir aller hyemit im woren glauben sein todt, für uns gelitten, bedencken und uffnemen, Das wir gewißlich glauben, du wöllest unser gnediger, barmhertziger vatter sein, der du uns zu kindern und erben hast uffgenommen, gleichförmig zu werden deinem aller liebsten und erstgebornen sun Jhesu Christo, wiewol mir noch hie wie in sünden also auch in stäter trübsal leben, das wir auch uns alle durch einander als wore brüder und deine kinder halten, bereyt, dir zu gefallen, guts zethun, auch dein ruth und bewerung mit aller gedult allweg uffzunemen, und also gantz gutwillig erwarten, wann du uns vom leib der sünden erlöst. Disen glauben, hoffnung und lieb wöllestu, himlischer vatter, in uns stercken und befestigen, uff das wir in der warheit und rechten geist zu dir ruffen und bitten mögen, wie uns unser einiger leermeister gelert hat, und sprechen: Unser vatter in dem hymel, Dein namm sey heylig. […] Dann dein ist das reich und die krafft und die herrligkeit in ewigkeit, Amen.

*And instead of the Canon the following prayer is used:* Almighty God, and Father of our Saviour Jesus Christ, who by the same thy most dear Son, our Lord, hast promised that whatsoever we ask thee in his name thou wilt grant us, and hast moreover by thy Holy Ghost commanded us to pray for all rulers and all men: we beseech thee from our hearts, through the same thy most dear Son, our Saviour, that thou wouldest enlighten the heart of all princes and lords, and specially of our rulers, the honourable Council, with the knowledge of thy holy Gospel, that they may acknowledge thee for their right and only Sovereign, and govern us, the work of thy hands and the sheep of thy pasture, according to thy will and pleasure. And vouchsafe unto all men to come to the knowledge of thy truth; and unto this thy congregation, here present and gathered in thy name, thy Holy Ghost, the Comforter, who writeth thy law in our hearts, that our inborn blindness and folly may be taken away, whereby we not only cannot know our sin and evil, but are well pleased with ourselves therein. Therefore, O merciful God, most dear, make our sin alive in us by thy Holy Ghost, that we may feel it and know its vileness and shame; and that thence, seeing we find in ourselves nothing but sin, death and hell, we may obtain a true hunger and thirst for thy grace and mercy, that we may yet in part consider, receive with rightly-formed faith, and praise with everlasting thankfulness thy overflowing, unmeasurable grace and goodness, which thou hast shown us in this, that thou wouldest have thine only-begotten Son become man (that is, like unto us poor sinners), suffer and die for us, and by his death redeem us from sin, death and hell. Grant us now therefore, heavenly Father, that we may never let the wholesome remembrance of this death, whereby we are redeemed from all evil unto everlasting life, go out of our hearts; that we also with him, our Saviour, may die unto sin and live unto righteousness, in all patience and love toward our neighbour, with joyful watching, awaiting the blessed hope and coming of the same our dear Lord and Redeemer. And grant that we may at this time also keep his holy Supper unto such wholesome and needful remembrance with such a heart that we seek not things temporal nor our own, but the rising of thy kingdom, and desire to be loosed from sin and furthered unto all godliness; that none of us become guilty of the body or the blood of our Saviour Jesus Christ, nor eat judgement and damnation to himself, if he here confess himself to be a member of Christ, and believe that alone by the sacrifice which he once offered up for us on the cross unto thee, O Father, his body and blood, and yet had not such faith as is active through love toward all, and so made a mockery with the Supper of our Lord; but that we all herewith in true faith may consider and receive his death suffered for us; that we may surely believe that thou wilt be our gracious and merciful Father, who hast taken us to be children and heirs, to be conformed to thy most dear and first-begotten Son Jesus Christ, although we still live here as in sins, so also in continual tribulation; that we also may all hold one another as true brethren and thy children, ready to do good to please thee, also to take up thy rod and trial alway with all patience, and so to wait altogether willingly for the time when thou shalt deliver us from the body of sin. This faith, hope and love vouchsafe, heavenly Father, to strengthen and establish in us, that we may call and pray unto thee in truth and in right spirit, as our only Master hath taught us, and say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. […] For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever, Amen.

**Note.**

- **The rubric.** "Und anstatt des Canon braucht man diß nachgend gebett". The heading says outright what the prayer is for.
- **How it grows out of Schwarz.** It begins with Schwarz's *Te igitur* substitute (§7.5.1) and continues with the second hand's addition there. It runs into the Our Father, as Schwarz's *Post elevationem* did, but without Verba between.
- **Canon themes, recast:**
  - intercession for rulers and "diser deiner gemein, hye zu gegen" (*Te igitur*, *Memento … omnium circumstantium*);
  - the remembrance of the Son's death, resurrection and coming ("dises todts … heylsame gedechtnüß", "harrende auff … zukunfft"), which does the work of the *anamnesis* of *Unde et memores*;
  - a petition for a fruitful communion (*Supplices … ut quotquot … sumpserimus*), turned into a warning against eating judgement (1 Cor 11:27–29).
- **The one sacrifice.** The only sacrifice named is Christ's own, "so er einmal für uns am creütz dir, o vatter, uff geopffert hat sein leib und blut" (Heb 9:28; 10:14). Here the critique the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order would make in 1533 is already in the prayer itself (see Appendix 7.A).
- **No Verba.** This prayer is not followed by the Verba but by the Our Father. The Verba come after an admonition (below), read as a lesson from 1 Cor 11. There is no elevation.

> *Nach disem gebet ermanet der diener das volck, zu betrachten das leyden des herren nach yngegebnen gnaden, und beschleüßts gwonlich also:* So wöllen nun vernemen, wie der herr sein nachtmal gestalten hab, und was er zu thun befolhen hat. *Unnd liset die wort des nachtmals auß der ersten Epistel Pauli am 11. capitel zu den Corinthern mit dapffern worten wie hye nach:* Der herr Jhesus, in der nacht, da er verraten ward, nam er das brot und, als er gedanckt hatt, brach ers unnd gab es seinen jüngeren und sprach: Nement hyn unnd essen. Diß ist mein leib, der für eüch hyn gegeben wirt. Solchs thunt zu meiner gedechtnüß. Des selben gleichen auch den kelch, nach dem sye zu obent gessen hatten, und sprach: Diß ist der kelch, das neüw Testament in meinem blut, das für eüch unnd für vil zu ablösung der sünd vergossen würt. Sollichs thut, so offt ir gedrinckt, in meiner gedechtnüß. *Darnach spricht der diener zu dem volck:* So kumment nun här, die ir wöllent mitt mir des herren nachtmal halten und entpfahen. Er wöl uch dazu geschickt machen und verleyhen, sein todt mit rechtem glauben zu bedencken und mit warer danckbarkeit verkünden. *Und in dargebung des brots und des kelchs des herren spricht er also:* Gedenckent, glaubent, verkündent, das Christus für uch gestorben ist.

*After this prayer the minister exhorteth the people to consider the passion of the Lord, according to the grace given, and commonly concludeth it thus:* Let us now hear how the Lord ordained his Supper, and what he hath commanded to be done. *And he readeth the words of the Supper out of the first Epistle of Paul to the Corinthians, the eleventh chapter, with earnest words, as here followeth:* The Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, and when he had given thanks, he brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, and eat. This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me. After the same manner also the cup, when they had supped at evening, and said: This is the cup, the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the loosing of sin. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. *Thereafter the minister saith to the people:* Come ye now hither, that will with me keep and receive the Supper of the Lord. May he make you meet thereto, and grant you to consider his death with right faith and to show it forth with true thankfulness. *And in the giving of the bread and of the cup of the Lord he saith thus:* Remember, believe, and show forth that Christ died for you.

**Note.**

- **The *Pax*.** "So kumment nun här …" takes the place of the *Pax* and the invitation to communion.
- **"Gedenckent, glaubent, verkündent …"** replaces the *custodiat*. Form f keeps it.

#### 7.5.3 *Straßburger kirchen ampt*, 1525 (form f)

The last form drops the Preface and Sanctus. After the Creed comes an explanatory rubric and a still longer bidding:

> *Noch endung des glaubens, uff das die unchristlichen opffermessen dem volck nitt ein anstoß bringen und auff das verstanden werde, wie Christus für uns ein mal geopfert sey zur volkomnen gnugthuung unser sünd, Spricht der pfarher zu zeyten also:* Lieben brüder unnd schwester, Bitten Gott, den vatter, durch unsern herrn Jesum Christum, der in todt zur erlösung unser seelen geben ist, das er uns den heyligen geyst zusende, der uns lere auffopffern nit Christum, der sich selb ein mal für uns geopffert hatt unnd von niemane mag geopffert werden, sonder die gottgefelligen waren opffer, alls ein zerbrochnen geist, ein zerschlagen hertz, und das wir unser leyb zum opffer, das lebendig, heylig und im wolgefellig

> sey, begeben, Welchs unser vernünfftiger gotts dienst ist, in dem wir Gott eer, preyß und dancksagung opfferen. Der herr wölle eüch erhören und sein heyl erzeygen, Amen.

*After the ending of the Creed, that the unchristian sacrificial Masses may not be a stumbling-block to the people, and that it may be understood how Christ was once offered for us for the full satisfaction of our sins, the pastor sometimes speaketh thus:* Dear brethren and sisters, pray God the Father, through our Lord Jesus Christ, who was given into death for the redemption of our souls, that he send us the Holy Ghost, who may teach us to offer up, not Christ, who offered himself once for us and can be offered by no man, but the true sacrifices well-pleasing to God, as a broken spirit, a contrite heart; and that we yield our bodies a sacrifice, living, holy and well-pleasing unto him, which is our reasonable service, wherein we offer unto God honour, praise and thanksgiving. The Lord hear you and show you his salvation, Amen.

**Note.**

- **The last trace of the *Orate fratres*.** It is now a polemic against the Mass-sacrifice. Sehling refers to Bucer's argument from Hebrews in the same years.
- **What follows.** "Der herr sey mit eüch. Lassent uns bitten:" introduces the revised prayer of form e, "Almechtiger, barmhertziger Got und vater …". It is shorter on the magistrates and longer on the unity of the members of Christ's body ("des glider wir alle sein … durch die gelenck der liebe, mitt dem band des fridens … ingeleibt").
- **The Supper itself.** The Our Father; an exhortation (a specimen from St. Peter the Younger, Reminiscere 1525, is printed); the Verba from 1 Cor 11; the invitation; the distribution with "Gedencken, glauben und verkünden …".
- **The end of the Canon at Strasbourg.** Nothing of the Roman Canon is left but its intercession and its remembrance, both prayed in the congregation's own words.

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## 7.6 Worms, *Deutsche Messe*, 1524

*Form und Ordenung der Evangelischen deutschen Messen, wie sie zu Worms gehalten wird.* Sehling 19, III, Nr. 1, pp. 124–129. Like its Strasbourg original, it is a Moderate Reformed order.

The preface says this Mass is kept "zu Straßburg und Worms". This is the Strasbourg German Mass of 1524 (§7.5) in use at Worms, with the Canon prayers that Schwarz's Strasbourg manuscript lacks.

It keeps more of the Canon than any other order in the corpus. The Canon runs in its proper order from *Te igitur* to *Supplices te rogamus*, each prayer translated and trimmed. There are three kinds of change:

- **Sacrificial nouns replaced.**
  - *haec dona, haec munera, haec sancta sacrificia illibata* becomes "diß dein brot und wein";
  - *hostiam puram* becomes "unser demütiges gebet";
  - *hanc oblationem* becomes "uns und … unser gebet".
- **Office-holders replaced.** Pope and bishop give way to emperor, king and rulers.
- **Saints dropped.** The saints, the dead and the doxology *Per ipsum* are gone.

The Canon still stands between the Sanctus and the Our Father, where it belongs.

### 7.6.1 Preparation of the chalice (*Orate fratres*)

> *Bereytung des kelchs.* Liben Brüder und schwestern, bitten got, das mein und ewer gebet angenem sei. Der herr sei mit euch. *Antwort:* Und mit deinem geyst.

*The preparing of the cup.* Dear brethren and sisters, pray God that my prayer and yours may be acceptable. The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit.

**Note.** This is *Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem*, with *sacrificium* replaced by *gebet*. It follows the Creed directly. There is no offertory chant and there are no offertory prayers.

### 7.6.2 Preface and Sanctus

> *Prefatio.* Erhebt euwer hertzen zu gott. *Antwort:* Wir erhebens zu gott. Last unns dancksagen gott unßerem herrenn. *Antwort:* Das ist billich unnd recht. Ja, Warlich ist es billich und recht, auch heylsam, das wir an allen orten zu aller zeit dir, heyliger vater, Almechtiger, ewiger got, dancksagen durch Christum unsern herren: Durch welchen alle Engel und die himmlischen kräft anbetten, Eren unnd lobenn dein herliche maiestat, mit den selbigen bittenn wir, wöllest zuloßenn unnd annemen unßer stimm, das wir dich auch loben unnd sprechen on endt: Heyliger, Heyliger, Heyliger herr gott Sabaoth, vol sind hymmel und erde deiner herlickeyt. Osianna in den höchsten. Bene ✠ deiet sei, der do kümpt in dem namen des herren. Glück und heyl in den höchsten.

*The Preface.* Lift up your hearts unto God. *Answer:* We lift them up unto God. Let us give thanks unto God our Lord. *Answer:* It is meet and right. Yea, verily it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord: through whom all the angels and the heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy glorious majesty; with the same we beseech thee that thou wouldest admit and accept our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth; full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Bless ✠ ed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Prosperity and salvation in the highest.

**Note.** This is the common Preface. *Per quem maiestatem tuam laudant Angeli, adorant Dominationes, tremunt Potestates … cum quibus et nostras voces ut admitti iubeas deprecamur* is condensed. The second *Hosanna* is translated as "Glück und heyl" (prosperity and salvation). The sign of the cross at *Benedictus* is kept.

#### 7.6.3 *Te igitur*

> Darumb, aller güttigster vatter, bitten und begeren wir undertheniglich durch Jesum Christum, deinen sun, unsern heren, du wöllest diß dein brot und wein anschawen, gesegnen und bene ✠ deien. Auch unser gebet, so wir zu dem ersten für deine heylige Christliche kirchen thun, genediglichen annemen, dieselbigen befriden, behüten, vereynigen und regieren, durch den gantzen umbkreyß der weltt mit keyser, künig und allen unseren öbersten, mit sampt allen deinen Christgläubigen.

Wherefore, most gracious Father, we humbly pray and desire through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord, that thou wouldest look upon, bless and ble ✠ ss this thy bread and wine; and also graciously accept our prayer, which we make in the first place for thy holy Christian Church, and give peace to the same, keep, unite and govern it throughout the whole compass of the world, with the emperor, the king and all our rulers, together with all thy faithful Christians.

**Note.** Compare *Te igitur, clementissime Pater, per Iesum Christum Filium tuum Dominum nostrum supplices rogamus ac petimus, uti accepta habeas et benedicas haec dona, haec munera, haec sancta sacrificia illibata, in primis quae tibi offerimus pro Ecclesia tua sancta catholica: quam pacificare, custodire, adunare et regere digneris toto orbe terrarum: una cum famulo tuo Papa nostro N. et Antistite nostro N. et omnibus orthodoxis …*

- **Gifts and offering.** The gifts become "diß dein brot und wein". "*Quae tibi offerimus*" becomes the prayer "*so wir … thun*".
- **Office-holders.** Pope and bishop give way to emperor, king and "all our rulers".
- **Verbs for the Church.** The four verbs for the Church (*pacificare, custodire, adunare, regere*) are kept exactly.
- **Blessing.** *Accepta habeas et benedicas* is translated twice over ("gesegnen und bene ✠ deien"), as a bless-and-bless doublet.

#### 7.6.4 *Memento* of the living, with the end of *Communicantes*

> O herr, gedenck aller deiner diener und dienerin und aller umstender, deren glauben und andacht dir wyssen ist, für der selen und leibs heyl wir dich bitten, uff das wir alle durch hilff deines schirms bewaret werden durch Jesum Christum, unseren herren.

O Lord, remember all thy servants and handmaidens, and all that stand round about, whose faith and devotion is known unto thee, for whose health of soul and body we pray thee; that we all may be preserved by the help of thy protection; through Jesus Christ our Lord.

**Note.** This is *Memento, Domine, famulorum famularumque tuarum N. et N., et omnium circumstantium, quorum tibi fides cognita est et nota devotio*.

- **Offering removed.** *Pro quibus tibi offerimus: vel qui tibi offerunt hoc sacrificium laudis* becomes "für … wir dich bitten".

- **Ending borrowed from *Communicantes*.** The ending "uff das wir alle durch hilff deines schirms bewaret werden" is the last clause of *Communicantes*: *ut in omnibus protectionis tuae muniamur auxilio*.
- **Saints dropped.** The list of saints between these two points is gone.

#### 7.6.5 *Hanc igitur*

> Darumb bitten wir: O herr, wöllest dich unser und aller unser gebet genediglich annemen und alle unsere zeit noch deinem friden ordnen, von ewiger verdamniß erlösen und under die scharen deiner außerwelten zelen durch Christum, unseren herren, Amen.

Wherefore we pray: O Lord, vouchsafe graciously to take unto thee us and all our prayer, and to order all our days in thy peace, to deliver us from eternal damnation, and to number us among the flocks of thine elect; through Christ our Lord. Amen.

**Note.** This is *Hanc igitur oblationem servitutis nostrae … quaesumus, Domine, ut placatus accipias: diesque nostros in tua pace disponas, atque ab aeterna damnatione nos eripi, et in electorum tuorum iubeas grege numerari*. "*Oblationem*" becomes "uns und aller unser gebet".

The same words, "von der ewigen verdamnus erlösen", are what the 1533/1543 critique singles out as sacrificial (Appendix 7.A).

#### 7.6.6 *Quam oblationem*

> O aller güttigster vatter, barmhertziger, ewiger got, hilff und schaff, das dises brot und der wein uns werd und sei der warhafftig leib und das unschüldig blut deines aller liebstenn suns, unsers herren Jesu Christi.

O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, help and grant that this bread and the wine may become and be unto us the true body and the innocent blood of thy most dearly beloved Son, our Lord Jesus Christ.

**Note.** This is *Quam oblationem tu, Deus, in omnibus, quaesumus, benedictam, adscriptam, ratam, rationabilem, acceptabilemque facere digneris: ut nobis Corpus et Sanguis fiat dilectissimi Filii tui Domini nostri Iesu Christi*.

"Uns werd und sei" renders *nobis … fiat* exactly. The five adjectives of offering are dropped.

#### 7.6.7 *Qui pridie, Simili modo, Haec quotiescumque*

> Welcher an dem tag vor dem, als er gelitten hat, Nam er das brot, saget danck, Segnet ✠ und brach das brot und gab es seinen jüngeren, sprechendt: Nemen[t] hinn und essent, das ist mein leib, der für euch geben wirt. *Auffhebung des Sacraments.* Des gleichen nach dem abentmal. Nam er den kelch, dancket, Segnet ✠ und gab ien seinen jüngeren und sprach: Nement hinn, drincket alle daruß, das ist der kelch des newen und ewigen testaments in meinem blut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirt, zu vergebung der sünden. Dises, so manches mal ir das thut, so thut das mir zu eyner gedechtnuß. *Auffhebung des kelchs.*

Who, on the day before he suffered, took the bread, gave thanks, bless ✠ ed and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you. *The elevation of the Sacrament.* Likewise after the supper he took the cup, gave thanks, bless ✠ ed, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take, drink ye all thereof; this is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. This, as oft as ye do it, do it in remembrance of me. *The elevation of the cup.*

**Note.** The Verba keep the Roman Canon's frame:

- "an dem tag vor dem, als er gelitten hat" renders *Qui pridie quam pateretur*;
- "des newen und ewigen testaments" renders *novi et aeterni testamenti*;
- "Dises, so manches mal ir das thut" renders *Haec quotiescumque feceritis*.

Two things are dropped: *elevatis oculis in caelum* and *mysterium fidei*. "Der für euch geben wirt", from Luke and Paul, is added to the bread word.

#### 7.6.8 *Unde et memores* and *Supra quae*

> Des halbenn, herr, wir deine diener betrachten des selbigen deines suns, unsers herren Jesu Christi leiden und sterben, aufferstentnuß von der hellenn unnd auch herliche auffart zu den hymmelen, deiner götlichen maiestat, da mit anbieten unser demütiges gebet, daruff du mitt genedigem gütigen angesicht schawen und dir das gefallen lassest durch Jesum Christum, unsern herren.

Wherefore, O Lord, we thy servants, considering the passion and death of the same thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ, his resurrection from hell, and also his glorious ascension into the heavens, do therewith offer unto thy divine majesty our humble prayer; whereupon thou wouldest look with a gracious and kindly countenance, and let it be well-pleasing unto thee; through Jesus Christ our Lord.

**Note.** This is *Unde et memores, Domine, nos servi tui … eiusdem Christi Filii tui Domini nostri tam beatae passionis, nec non et ab inferis resurrectionis, sed et in caelos gloriosae ascensionis: offerimus praeclarae maiestati tuae de tuis donis ac datis hostiam puram …*, joined to *Supra quae propitio ac sereno vultu respicere digneris: et accepta habere …*.

- **What is offered.** The Canon's *offerimus* is kept ("anbieten"), but what is offered is "unser demütiges gebet", not the *hostia*.
- **Literal rendering.** "Aufferstentnuß von der hellenn" renders *ab inferis resurrectionis* literally.
- **Types dropped.** The Old Testament types (Abel, Abraham, Melchizedek) are gone.

#### 7.6.9 *Supplices te rogamus*

> Almechtiger got, wir bitten dich demütiglichen, schaff, das unser gebet unnd begird uff den höchsten altar für das angesicht deiner götlichenn maiestat fürbracht werdt, da mitt wir alle so von diesem aller heyligsten abentmol des leibs, fleysch und bluts deines sunes entpfahen, mitt allem götlichen segen und gnaden erfüllet werdenn. Durch den selben Jesum Christum, unseren herren. Amen.

Almighty God, we humbly beseech thee, grant that our prayer and desire may be brought upon the highest altar before the face of thy divine majesty; that we all, who from this most holy supper receive the body, flesh and blood of thy Son, may be filled with all divine blessing and grace. Through the same Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

**Note.** This is *Supplices te rogamus, omnipotens Deus: iube haec perferri per manus sancti Angeli tui in sublime altare tuum, in conspectu divinae maiestatis tuae: ut quotquot ex hac altaris participatione sacrosanctum Filii tui Corpus et Sanguinem sumpserimus, omni benedictione caelesti et gratia repleamur. Per eundem Christum …*

- **What is carried up.** "*Haec*" (the gifts) becomes "unser gebet unnd begird".
- **The angel.** The angel who carries them is dropped.
- **The altar.** *Ex hac altaris participatione* becomes "von diesem aller heyligsten abentmol".

#### 7.6.10 Our Father, with the conclusion of the embolism

> *Last uns betten.* Auß ermanung der seligen gebot und götlicher ordnung underwißen, dörffen wir sagen: Vatter unser, der du bist in den hymmeln. etc. Durch Jesum Christum, unsern herren, deinen sun, welcher mit dir und dem heyligen geyst, eyn warer got, lebt und herschet. Amen.

*Let us pray.* Out of the admonition of the blessed commandments, and by divine ordinance instructed, we are bold to say: Our Father, which art in the heavens, etc. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth. Amen.

**Note.** The introduction to the Our Father is *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti, et divina institutione formati, audemus dicere*.

The doxology after it is the ending of the embolism, *Per eundem Dominum nostrum Iesum Christum Filium tuum, qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitate Spiritus Sancti Deus*. The body of the embolism (*Libera nos, quaesumus, Domine, ab omnibus malis …*, with its saints) is dropped. Only its conclusion remains.

#### 7.6.11 Fraction forbidden; the Peace as absolution

> *Der prister darff die hostia nit brechen, noch in kelch fellen.* Der frid des herren sei alwegen mit euch. *Das ist die rechte Evangelische absolucio, so den glaubigen der sünd ablas verkündet, die eynige und würdigste bereittung zu der entpfengnüs*

> *des leibs und bluts Christi. Möcht wol vom prister, gegen dem volck gekört, gesprochen werdenn.*

*The priest may not break the host, nor let it fall into the cup.* The peace of the Lord be alway with you. *This is the right evangelical absolution, which proclaimeth unto the faithful the remission of sin, the only and most worthy preparation for the receiving of the body and blood of Christ. It may well be spoken by the priest turned toward the people.*

**Note.** The fraction and the commixture (*Haec commixtio* …) are forbidden. Sehling compares Luther's *Formula missae*. *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* is kept, and the rubric explains it as a public absolution.

#### 7.6.12 *Agnus Dei* and communion

> *Agnus dei.* Du lemlin gottes, das du hinnimpst die sund der welt, Erbarm dich uber uns. Und verleihe uns den friden. *Hie teyle der prister den leib und blut denen, so es begeren. Er selbs niess es nit, er hab dan sonderlichen hunger dazu.* Secht, aller liebsten, das ist warlichen der heylig leychnam unsers herren Jesu Christi, der für euch gelitten hat den biteren todt. Nemet hinn und essen ien, das er euch speiß, nere und bewar in das ewig leben. Der leib des herren Jesu Christi behüt dein seel in das ewig leben. *Nimpt der prister den kelch und spricht:* Last uns auch drincken den kelch des heyls und anruffen den namen des herren. Secht, das ist warlichen der thewer schatz des kostbarlichen bluts unsers herren Jesu Christi, da mit ir erkaufft seindt. Nement hinn und theylens mitt eynander zu abweschung ewrer sündt. Amen. Das blut unsers herren Jesu Christi behüt dein seel und mein seel in das ewig leben.

*Agnus Dei.* Thou little Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. And grant us peace. *Here let the priest distribute the body and blood to them that desire it. He himself shall not partake of it, unless he have a special hunger thereto.* Behold, dearly beloved, this is verily the holy body of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat it, that it may feed, nourish and preserve you unto everlasting life. The body of the Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life. *The priest taketh the cup and saith:* Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord. Behold, this is verily the dear treasure of the precious blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take and divide it among yourselves, unto the washing away of your sins. Amen. The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul and my soul unto everlasting life.

**Note.**

- **Communion formulas.** "Der leib … behüt dein seel in das ewig leben" is *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam*. The cup formula is *Sanguis Domini nostri* … in the same way.
- **The priest's cup verse.** "Last uns auch drincken den kelch des heyls" is the priest's *Calicem salutaris accipiam, et nomen Domini invocabo* (Ps 116:13), put into the plural.
- **"Secht".** Each "Secht" (*Ecce*) introduces a showing of the element to the people.
- **"Theylens mitt eynander".** This is Luke 22:17.
- **The priest's own communion.** The priest communicates only "if he have a special hunger thereto".

#### 7.6.13 Postcommunion, *Benedicamus*, blessing, *Nunc dimittis*

> Der herr sei mitt euch. *Antwort:* Und mitt deinem geist. *Last uns betten:* O herr Jesu Christe, dein aller heyligster leib, den wir handt genossen, und dein unschuldiges blut, das wir haben gedruncken, wel uns nitt sein zu der verdamnuß, noch zu dem gericht, sonder nach deiner gütte zu eynnem schirm und artznei der selen und des leibs, eyn fürdernuß zu dem ewigen leben, der du lebest und regierst in ewigkeyt. Amen. Der herr sei mit euch. *Antwort:* Und mitt deinem geyst. Last uns gott gebenedeien. Danck, lob, ere unnd preiß sei gott durch Christum, unsern herren, Amen. *Benedictio:* Der segen des Almechtigen gottes, vatters, suns und heyligen geyst, sei mit euch und bleib alweg bei euch. Amen. *Nunc dimittis:* O her, laß im frid deinen diener noch deinem wort, Dann unsere augen haben gesehen dein heylandt, welchen du bereyt hast vor dem angesicht aller völcker, das liech[t] zu erleuchten die heyden und zu eyner glori deines völcks Israel, dir sei lob, ere und danck, gebenedeiet, heilige dreivaltickeyt, got vatter, sun und heyliger geyst. Amen.

The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. *Let us pray:* O Lord Jesus Christ, may thy most holy body which we have partaken, and thy innocent blood which we have drunk, be unto us neither unto damnation nor unto judgement, but, according to thy goodness, unto a defence and medicine of the soul and of the body, a furtherance unto everlasting life; who livest and reignest for ever. Amen. The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. Let us bless God. Thanks, praise, honour and glory be to God through Christ our Lord. Amen. *The Blessing:* The blessing of Almighty God, Father, Son and Holy Ghost, be with you and

remain alway with you. Amen. *Nunc dimittis:* O Lord, let thy servant depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, the light to lighten the Gentiles and to be the glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise, honour and thanks, blessed, holy Trinity, God Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen.

**Note.**

- **The postcommunion.** It joins two of the priest's communion prayers. The first is *Perceptio Corporis tui, Domine Iesu Christe … non mihi proveniat in iudicium et condemnationem: sed pro tua pietate prosit mihi ad tutamentum mentis et corporis, et ad medelam percipiendam*. The second is *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsi, et Sanguis, quem potavi* …. Both are made into a public collect.
- **The dismissal.** "Last uns gott gebenedeien" is *Benedicamus Domino*, and the response is an expanded *Deo gratias*.
- **The blessing.** It is *Benedicat vos omnipotens Deus, Pater et Filius et Spiritus Sanctus*.

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## 7.7 Nürnberg, 1524–1525: the parish churches, Volprecht, and the *Form und Ordnung*

Three Nürnberg orders sit alongside Döber's Mass (§7.8):

| Order | Sehling | `eko.db` doc | Pages |
|---|---|---|---|
| *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen* (St. Sebald, St. Lorenz), June 1524, Latin | 11, I.5 | 249 | 46–47 |
| *Deutsche Messe des Priors Volprecht* (Augustinians), 1524 | 11, I.3 | 247 | 41–42 |
| *Form und Ordnung einer Christlichen Messe*, 1525 | 11, I.7 | 251 | 57 |

The parish order is Latin and follows the *Formula missae* closely. Volprecht's German Mass is the most conservative in the corpus after Worms (Moderate Reformed). It keeps all three of the priest's prayers before communion and both ablution prayers, translated.

### 7.7.1 The parish churches, 1524 (Latin)

> *Symbolo finito, offertorio ac canone minore omissis incipit Celebrans:* Dominus vobiscum. Sursum corda. Gratias agamus Domino Deo nostro. Vere dignum et iustum est, equum et salutare, nos tibi semper et ubique gratias agere, Domine sancte pater omnipotens, eterne Deus, per Christum Dominum nostrum. *Hic finitur prefatio. Chorus:* Sanctus, sanctus. *Celebrans autem subiungit legendo:* Qui pridie, quam pateretur, accepit panem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas et elevatis oculis in celum ad te, Deum Patrem omnipotentem, tibi gratias agens benedicit, fregit, dedit discipulis suis dicens: Accipite et manducate ex hoc omnes! Hoc est enim corpus meum. *Elevatur panis.* Simili modo, postquam cenatum est, accipiens et hunc preclarum calicem in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas, item tibi gratias agens benedixit, dedit discipulis suis dicens: Accipite et bibite ex eo omnes! Hic est enim calix sanguinis mei, novi et eterni testamenti, misterium fidei, qui pro nobis et pro multis effundetur in remissionem peccatorum. *Elevatur calix. Finito Osanna in excelsis celebrans incipit,* Oremus preceptis salutaribus moniti etc.: Pater noster, qui est in etc. *Posthac admonetur populus sacramentum sumpturus his verbis:* […] *Subiungit deinde celebrans:* Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum. *Chorus respondet. Incipiatur dein populus comunicari, officiante panem prebente et ministro calicem. Sub comunione chorus canit: Agnus Dei et comunionem. Tardius aut velocius iuxta hominum communicantium numerum administrato sacramento, siquid superest a celebrante et ministrantibus sumitur. Demum offitium cum oratione, quam complendam vocant, concludatur.*

*The Creed ended, the offertory and the lesser canon being omitted, the celebrant beginneth:* The Lord be with you. Lift up your hearts. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is very meet and right, fitting and wholesome, that we should at all times and in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord. *Here the Preface endeth. Choir:* Holy, holy. *But the celebrant addeth, reading:* Who the day before he suffered took bread into his holy and venerable hands, and with eyes lifted up to heaven unto thee, God the almighty Father, giving thanks unto thee, blesseth, brake, gave to his disciples, saying: Take and eat ye all of this! For this is my body. *The bread is elevated.* In like manner, after they had supped, taking also this excellent cup into his holy and venerable hands, again giving thanks unto thee, he blessed, gave to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all of it! For this is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, the mystery of faith, which shall be shed for us and for many unto the remission of sins. *The cup is elevated. The Hosanna in excelsis being ended, the celebrant beginneth,* Let us pray: Taught by wholesome precepts, etc.: Our Father, which art in, etc. *After this the*

*people who are to receive the sacrament are admonished in these words:* [...] *Then the celebrant addeth:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you. *The choir answereth. Then let the people begin to be communicated, the officiant offering the bread and the minister the cup. During the communion the choir singeth the Agnus Dei and the communion. The sacrament having been administered more slowly or more quickly according to the number of persons communicating, if anything remaineth it is consumed by the celebrant and the ministers. Lastly let the office be concluded with the prayer which they call the complenda.*

**Note.**

- **"offertorio ac canone minore omissis".** Sehling explains that the offertory part of the Mass was often called the *canon minor*, the Canon proper being the *canon maior*. Both are left out.
- **The Preface** is cut short at *per Christum Dominum nostrum*, as in the *Formula missae* (§7.3.2). But here the Sanctus is sung after it.
- ***Qui pridie*** is the full Roman text, *mysterium fidei* included. It is read quietly ("legendo") during the Sanctus and Benedictus, with the two elevations. Sehling (note 17) reads the rubric so: in June 1524 the words were still said in Latin and quietly, as the *Formula missae* allowed ("vel silenter vel palam"). By March 1525 Nürnberg reported that they were sung aloud "in dem tone oder melodei der prefation", with the Sanctus after them.
  - The print reads "pro nobis", where the Roman text has *pro vobis*.
  - "paterctur" and "cafix" are corrected here.
- **The exhortation** is the Nürnberg one printed at §7.8.7.
- ***Pax Domini*** follows the exhortation, as in Döber.
- **No embolism, no fraction.**
- **The postcommunion.** The *complenda* is the proper postcommunion of the day. Luther had rejected the variable postcommunions (§7.3.5).

### 7.7.2 Volprecht, 1524

> *Hic sacerdos praeparat calicem. Statim eo praeparito [!] dicat:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Antwort:* Und mit deinem gaist! *Briester:* Hebt auf die herzen! *Antwort:* Wir hebens zum Herrn! *Briester:* Laßt uns danksagen Gott unsern Herren! *Antwort:* Das ist billig und recht. *Prefatio:* Warlich ist es billich und recht. Das ist ziemlich und hailwertig, das wir allwegen und allzeit danksagen, du heiliger Herr, allmechtiger Vater, ewiger Gott, durch Christum unsern Herrn, welcher in der nacht, da er verraten ward, hat er genummen das brot, dank gesagt Gott seinem himlischen Vater, das brochen und geben seinen jungern sprechende: Kommet und esset! Das ist mein leib, der fur euch dargeben wird. Das tut zu meiner gedechtnus! Deshalben gleichen nahm er auch den kelch, nachdem sie zu abent gessen hetten, saget dank Gott seinem himlischen Vater und gab in inen sprechende: Nemet hin! Trinket aus im alle! Das ist der kelch, das neu testament in meinem blut, welches fur euch und fur vil vergossen wird zu verzeihung der sund. Solches tut, so oft ihrs trinkt, zu meiner gedechtnus! Heilig, heilig, heilig ist Gott der Herr allmechtig. Himmel und erden sein voll deiner glori. Mach uns selig in der hohe! Gebenedeiet sei, der da kumpt in dem namen des Herrn! Mach uns selig in der hohe!

*Here the priest prepareth the chalice. As soon as it is prepared let him say:* The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Priest:* Lift up the hearts! *Answer:* We lift them up unto the Lord! *Priest:* Let us give thanks unto God our Lord! *Answer:* That is meet and right. *Preface:* Verily it is meet and right. It is seemly and wholesome that we should always and at all times give thanks, thou holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord; who in the night in which he was betrayed took the bread, gave thanks unto God his heavenly Father, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Come and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! After the same manner he took also the cup, when they had eaten at evening, gave thanks unto God his heavenly Father, and gave it to them, saying: Take! Drink ye all of it! This is the cup, the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! Holy, holy, holy is God the Lord almighty. Heaven and earth are full of thy glory. Save us in the highest! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord! Save us in the highest!

**Note.**

- **The chalice.** "Hic sacerdos praeparat calicem" is all that is left of the offertory, as in Döber (§7.8.1). It stands after the Creed, where the Roman offertory stood.
- **The Preface and Verba.** The Preface cut off at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* runs into the Verba on the pattern of the *Formula missae*. Sehling: "selbständige Übersetzung der von Luther geschaffenen Einleitung des Einsetzungsberichtes". The Verba are from 1 Cor 11 and the Gospels, not from *Qui pridie*.

- **The Sanctus** comes after the Verba. "Mach uns selig" translates *Hosanna* (Sehling: "Hilf doch!").

> *Briester:* Last uns bitten durch heilsame gebet erinnert: Vater unser, der du bist in dem himmel, geheiligt werd dein nam! Zukum dein reich! Dein will der geschee als im himmel und auf erden! Unser täglich brod gieb uns heut und vergib uns unser schuld als wir vergeben unser schuldigern! Und nit einfur uns in versuchung, sonder erlös uns vom ubl! Amen. *Der briester kert sich zum volk sprechende:* Der frid des Herren sei allzeit mit euch! *Antwort:* Und mit deinem geist! O du lemlein Gottes, welches du weg nimbst die sund der welt, erbarm dich unser! O du lemlein Gottes, welches du weg nimbst die sund der welt, erbarm dich unser! O du lemlein Gottes, welches du weg nimbst die sund der welt, erbarm dich unser und gib uns den frid!

*Priest:* Let us pray, admonished by wholesome precepts: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come! Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Amen. *The priest turneth to the people, saying:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us peace!

**Note.**

- **"Last uns bitten durch heilsame gebet erinnert".** This is *Oremus: Praeceptis salutaribus moniti*, with *praecepta* ("precepts") read as "gebet".
- **The *Pax*** is kept with its Roman response. There is no embolism and no fraction.

> O Herr Jesu Christe, du hast gesagt deinen jungern: Den frid gebe ich euch; meinen frid laß ich euch; nit gib ich ihn euch, wie die welt gibt, Hirumb, mein Herr, sich nit an unser sund, sonder den glauben deiner christlichen kirchen, die wir dan glauben und nit sehen, welche du nach deinem gottlichen willen, bewaren, vereinigen, regiren wollest mit deinem himlischen Vater und dem Heiligen Geist in ewigkeit. Amen. *Alia oratio:* O Herr Jesu Christe, du Sun des lebendigen Gottes, der du aus dem willen deines Vaters mit mitwurkung des Heiligen Geistes durch deinen tod die welt widerumb lebendig gemacht hast. Erlos uns durch die nemung deines leibs und bluts von allen unsern sunden und von allem ubl und gieb uns, das wir allzeit deinen göttlichen gepoten anhangen und nimmermer von dir geschiden werden! Der du mit Gott, deinem himlischen Vater und dem Heiligen Geist lebst und regirst in ewigkeit. Amen. *Alia oratio:* Die empfahung deines fleisch und bluts, Jesu Christe, das wir arme sünder nießen in vergebung unser sünd, gestatt uns nit zu einem urtel oder verdambnus, sonder sei unser beschirmung hie und dort in ewigkeit! Amen.

O Lord Jesu Christ, thou hast said unto thy disciples: Peace I give unto you; my peace I leave with you; not as the world giveth, give I it unto you. Wherefore, my Lord, look not upon our sins, but upon the faith of thy Christian Church, which we believe and see not; which vouchsafe thou, according to thy divine will, to keep, unite and govern, with thy heavenly Father and the Holy Ghost, for ever. Amen. *Another prayer:* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the will of thy Father, with the working together of the Holy Ghost, hast by thy death made the world alive again: deliver us by the taking of thy body and blood from all our sins and from all evil, and grant us that we may at all times cleave unto thy divine commandments, and never more be parted from thee! Who with God thy heavenly Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest for ever. Amen. *Another prayer:* Let the receiving of thy flesh and blood, Jesu Christ, which we poor sinners partake unto the forgiveness of our sins, not be suffered to turn to us unto judgement or damnation, but be our defence here and there for ever! Amen.

**Note.** These are the priest's three prayers before communion, in German, twenty years before Brandenburg kept them in Latin (§7.12.5). Sehling thought only one of them was meant to be chosen ("Alia oratio").

1. ***Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti.***
   - John 14:27 is given in full, including "not as the world giveth" (not in the Roman prayer).
   - "die wir dan glauben und nit sehen" is added.
   - The Tridentine verbs are *pacificare et coadunare*. Volprecht's "bewaren, vereinigen, regiren" are instead the *custodire, adunare et regere* of *Te igitur*, as in Brandenburg's Latin (§7.12.5).
2. ***Fili Dei vivi.***
   - *Per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum* becomes "durch die nemung deines leibs und bluts", "by the taking". The deliverance comes through receiving, not through the consecrated elements.
   - *Inhaerere* is kept ("anhangen").

    - The prayer is plural.
3. ***Perceptio Corporis tui.*** The body and blood are named ("fleisch und bluts").
    - *Praesumo* disappears; "in vergebung unser sünd" is added.
    - *Tutamentum mentis et corporis, et ad medelam percipiendam* is shortened to "beschirmung hie und dort".

> *Hic sumit corpus Christi dicendo:* Der leib unsers Herrn Jesus Christi, der für uns dargeben ist, bewar mein sel in das ewig leben! Amen. Last uns auch trinken den kelch des heils und anrufen den namen des Herrn! *Hic sumit sanguinem dicendo:* Das blut unsers Herrn Jesu Christi, das fur uns vergossen ist, bewar mein sel in das ewig leben! Amen. *Statim dicat:* Das wir haben empfangen mit dem mund, gib, allmechtiger Gott, das wirs auch empfahen mit reinem herzen, das aus einer zeitlichen gab uns werd ein ewigs erznei! *Alia oratio:* Der leib und das blut des Herrn, das wir empfangen haben, hang allzeit inwendig an unsern herzen und gib, allmechtiger Gott, das in uns nit bleib ein makel der sünd, der du uns hast gespeist mit deinem heiligen sacramenten!

*Here he receiveth the body of Christ, saying:* The body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is given for us, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! Amen. Let us also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord! *Here he receiveth the blood, saying:* The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, which is shed for us, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! Amen. *Straightway let him say:* What we have received with the mouth, grant, almighty God, that we may receive it also with a pure heart, that of a temporal gift it may become unto us an everlasting medicine! *Another prayer:* May the body and the blood of the Lord, which we have received, cleave alway inwardly unto our hearts; and grant, almighty God, that there remain not in us a stain of sin, who hast fed us with thy holy sacraments!

**Note.**

- **The priest's communion.**
    - ***Custodiat.*** "Bewar mein sel in das ewig leben" is *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam in vitam aeternam*. "der für uns dargeben ist" is added.
    - ***Calicem salutaris.*** "Last uns auch trinken den kelch des heils" is *Calicem salutaris accipiam* (Ps 116:13), plural, as in Kantz (§7.2.6).
- **The ablution prayers.**
    - ***Quod ore sumpsimus*** is complete: *Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus: et de munere temporali fiat nobis remedium sempiternum*.
    - ***Corpus tuum*** is made plural: *Corpus tuum, Domine, quod sumpsi, et Sanguis, quem potavi, adhaereat visceribus meis: et praesta, ut in me non remaneat scelerum macula, quem pura et sancta refecerunt sacramenta*. "Visceribus" becomes "inwendig an unsern herzen".
    - Sehling again thinks only one of the two was meant.
- **No communion of the people is provided for** in the text. The exhortation printed after the Mass (the Nürnberg exhortation, §7.8.7) is for those who "zu Gottes disch wollten gein, vor oder unter der mess".

> *Communio:* Wir loben Gott der himmel und bekennen vor allermeniglich lebendigen, das er mit uns gehandelt hat nach seiner barmherzigkeit. *Briester:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Antwort:* Und mit deinem geist! *Briester:* Last uns bitten! Die empfahung deines sacraments, o Herr, unser Gott, welchen wir haben genumen, kum uns zu hail laibs und auch der selen und zu bekenntnis der ewigen heiligen Trivaltigkeit und unzertailten Einigkeit durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, deinen Sohn, der mit dir lebt und herrscht in einigkeit des Heiligen Geists immer und ewiglich! Amen. *Briester:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Antwort:* Und mit deinem geist! *Darnach spricht der priester den segen also:* Der Herr gesegne euch und behüt euch! Der Herr erleucht sein angesicht uber euch und sei euch gnedig! Der Herr heb sein angesicht auf euch und geb euch den frid! *Antwort:* Amen. *Briester:* Last uns den Herrn lob und dank sagen! *Antwort:* Gott sei gedankt. *Finis misse.*

*Communion:* We praise the God of heaven, and confess before all that live, that he hath dealt with us according to his mercy. *Priest:* The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Priest:* Let us pray! May the receiving of thy sacrament, O Lord our God, which we have taken, come unto us for the health of body and also of soul, and for the confession of the eternal holy Trinity and undivided Unity; through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee liveth and reigneth in the unity of the Holy Ghost, ever and everlastingly! Amen. *Priest:* The Lord be with you! *Answer:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter the priest speaketh the blessing thus:* The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! *Answer:* Amen. *Priest:* Let us give praise and thanks unto the Lord! *Answer:* Thanks be to God. *The end of the Mass.*

**Note.**

- **The Mass is that of Trinity Sunday**, from the Bamberg missal. The communion chant is *Benedicimus Deum caeli, et coram omnibus viventibus confitebimur ei: quia fecit nobiscum misericordiam suam* (Tob 12:6).
- **The postcommunion** is the Roman postcommunion of Trinity Sunday: *Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae, Domine Deus noster, huius sacramenti susceptio: et sempiternae sanctae Trinitatis, eiusdemque individuae Unitatis confessio*. Lippe uses it too (§7.10).
- **The ending.** "Last uns den Herrn lob und dank sagen / Gott sei gedankt" is the *Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*. The Aaronic blessing (Luther's suggestion, §7.3.5) stands before it.

#### 7.7.3 *Form und Ordnung einer Christlichen Messe*, 1525

> *Nach dem hebt der priester die prefation an, dominicaliter:* Dominus vobiscum! *Chorus:* Et cum spiritu tuo! Sursum corda etc. bis daher, per Christum Dominum nostrum. *Darnach hebt er das Qui pridie an und, alsbald der priester elevirt hat, hebt der chor das Sanctus an. Nach demselben singt der priester das Pater noster, mit dem anfang:* Oremus praeceptis salutaribus etc. *Nach dem Pater noster list der priester oder ministrant die exhortation gegen dem volk:* Mein allerliebsten in Gott etc. *So dasselbig ein end hat, kert sich der priester gegen dem volk und singt:* Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum! *Chorus:* Et cum spiritu tuo! *Darnach hebt der chor das Agnus Dei an, wie dann hernach volgt. Dieweil communicirt der priester das volk und spricht mit ersten:* Der leib unsers Herrn Jesu Christi bewar dein seel zum ewigen leben! *Darnach:* Das blut unsers Herrn Jesu Christi beware dein seel zum ewigen leben! […] *Nach dem Agnus Dei von stund an hebt der chor ein psalm an für das commun oder sunst ein lied. Nach demselbigen beschleußt der priester die meß mit einer collecten. Darnach mit dem Benedicamus Domino, dominicaliter.*

*After that the priest beginneth the Preface, in the Sunday tone:* The Lord be with you! *Choir:* And with thy spirit! Lift up your hearts, etc., as far as "through Christ our Lord". *Thereafter he beginneth the Qui pridie, and as soon as the priest hath elevated, the choir beginneth the Sanctus. After the same the priest singeth the Pater noster, with the beginning:* Let us pray: Taught by wholesome precepts, etc. *After the Pater noster the priest or minister readeth the exhortation toward the people:* My dearly beloved in God, etc. *When that is ended, the priest turneth toward the people and singeth:* The peace of the Lord be alway with you! *Choir:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter the choir beginneth the Agnus Dei, as followeth hereafter. Meanwhile the priest communicateth the people and saith first:* The body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! *Then:* The blood of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! […] *Immediately after the Agnus Dei the choir beginneth a psalm for the communion, or else a hymn. After the same the priest concludeth the Mass with a collect. Thereafter with the Benedicamus Domino, in the Sunday tone.*

**Note.**

- **The shape.** This is the Mass of the parish churches (§7.7.1) as sung by 1525: shortened Preface, *Qui pridie* (Sehling: presumably sung in Latin), elevation, Sanctus, *Praeceptis salutaribus* and the Our Father, the exhortation, *Pax Domini*.
- **What is new** is the German *custodiat* at the distribution, in the second person.
- **What follows in the print.** The German Sanctus and *Agnus Dei* printed after the rubrics ("Lamb Gottes, das du wek nimbst die sünd der welt …") are omitted here.

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### 7.8 Nürnberg, Döber's *Deutsche Messe*, 1525

Andreas Döber's German Mass for the Neues Spital, Nürnberg. Sehling 11, I.6, pp. 52–55.

Döber follows the order Luther proposed in the *Formula missae* (1523), as Nürnberg's parish churches had done in 1524. There is no offertory. A truncated Preface runs straight into the Verba, and the Sanctus follows the Verba. Of the Canon, only the Verba remain in place. The Roman prayers after the Our Father survive as three things: a remnant of the embolism, a German *Agnus Dei*, and the *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi*, which is turned into a prayer for the people to repeat.

#### 7.8.1 Preparation of the gifts (after the Gradual)

> *Nach der epistel volgt das gradual. Nach demselben bereit der priester den kelch mit sambt dem brot.* […] *Nach dem alleluia fragt der priester den ministranten, ob sich jemand hab angesagt, das heilig sacrament zu empfahen. Darauf bereit er zu und, so dasselbig geschehen ist, wendt er sich zum volk oder legts buch aufs pult und lists evangelion Johan 6.*

*After the Epistle followeth the Gradual. After the same the priest prepareth the cup together with the bread.* […] *After the Alleluia the priest asketh the server whether any have announced himself to receive the holy sacrament. Thereupon he maketh ready; and when that is done, he turneth himself to the people, or layeth the book upon the desk, and readeth the Gospel, John 6.*

**Note.** This is all that is left of the offertory: a silent preparation, moved in front of the Gospel, with no prayers. The Nicene or Apostles' Creed follows the Gospel. The Mass then goes on at once to the Preface.

#### 7.8.2 Preface

> *Nach dem hebt der priester die prefation an:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Das volk:* Und mit deinem geist! *Der priester:* Erhebet euer herzen zu Got! *Das volk:* Wir haben unser herzen erhaben. *Der priester:* Last uns danksagen Got, unserm Herrn! *Das volk:* Es ist billich und recht. *Der priester:* Ja warlich, es ist billich und recht, auch heilsam, das wir an allen orten dir, Herr, heiliger Vater, almechtiger, ewiger Gott, dank sagen durch Christum unsern Herren. Amen.

*After that the priest beginneth the Preface:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *The priest:* Lift up your hearts unto God! *The people:* We have lifted up our hearts. *The priest:* Let us give thanks unto God our Lord! *The people:* It is meet and right. *The priest:* Yea verily, it is meet and right, and also wholesome, that we should in all places give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord. Amen.

**Note.** This is Luther's shortened Preface from the *Formula missae*. It was meant to end at *per Christum Dominum nostrum* and to run straight into the relative clause *Qui pridie*. Sehling notes that Döber's "Amen" breaks that join, and shows that Döber "did not understand its sense".

#### 7.8.3 The Verba

> *Darnach spricht der priester und nimbts brod in die hend:* Welcher in der nacht, do er verraten ward, nam er das brot in sein heilige hend, saget dank seinem himlischen Vater, segnets, brachs und gabs seinen jüngern und sprach zu ihnen: Nembt hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch dargeben würd. Das tut zu meiner gedechtnus! *Und zeigts dem volk. Nun nimbt er den kelck in die hand:* Desgleichen auch nam er den kelch in sein heilige händ, saget dank seinem himlischen Vater, segnets und gabs seinen jüngern und sprach: Nembt hin und drinkt aus disem alle! Das ist der kelch des neuen testaments mit meinem plut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirt zur verzeihung der sünden. Also oft ir das tut, so tuts zu meiner gedechtnus! *Und zeigts dem volk.*

*Thereafter the priest saith, and taketh the bread into his hands:* Who, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread into his holy hands, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said unto them: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! *And he showeth it to the people. Now he taketh the cup into his hand:* Likewise also he took the cup into his holy hands, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, do it in remembrance of me! *And he showeth it to the people.*

**Note.** The frame is the Canon's:

- "in sein heilige hend" renders *in sanctas ac venerabiles manus suas*;
- "saget dank seinem himlischen Vater" renders *ad te Deum Patrem suum omnipotentem, tibi gratias agens*;
- "Also oft ir das tut" renders *Haec quotiescumque feceritis*.

The opening, though, is Paul's "in der nacht, do er verraten ward" (1 Cor 11:23), not *Qui pridie*. In the 1524 order of the parish churches (Sehling 11, I.5, p. 47) the Verba were still said in Latin, *Qui pridie … Hoc est enim corpus meum … mysterium fidei*.

#### 7.8.4 Sanctus

> *Nach diesem spricht er das Sanctus, wie hernach volgt. Das sanctus:* Heiliger, heiliger, heiliger Herr Got Sabaoth. Vol sind die himel und ertrich deiner glori und herrlicheit. Ach, mach uns selig in der höhe! Gebenedeiet sei der da kumbt im namen des Herrn! Selig mach uns in den höhen!

*After this he saith the Sanctus, as followeth. The Sanctus:* Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of Sabaoth. Full are the heavens and the earth of thy glory and majesty. Ah, save us in the height! Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord! Save us in the heights!

**Note.** *Hosanna* is translated by its meaning, "help/save us" ("mach uns selig"), as in Volprecht's Mass of 1524.

#### 7.8.5 Our Father and the remnant of the embolism

> *Darnach soll der priester sprechen, wie Matthei am 6. stehet:* Als die jüngern zu dem Herrn Jesu kamen, baten in, er solt sie beten leren, do sprach er: Wenn ihr beten wölt, so solt ir nit vil plappern, wie die heuchler tun; denn sie meinen, wenn sie vil wort machen, so werden sie erhört. Sonder sprecht also wie denn hernach volgt: Vater unser, der du bist in den himeln, geheiliget werd dein name! Zukum uns dein reich! Dein wil geschehe als im himel und auf erden! Unser teglich brot gib uns heut und vergibe uns unsere schuld, als und wir vergeben unsern schuldigern! Und nit einfür uns in versuchung, sonder erlös uns von übel! Amen. *Und spricht weiter:* O Herr, erlös uns von allen sichtigen und unsichtigen feinden, von dem Teufel, von der welt, von unserm eigen fleisch durch Christum Jesum, unsern Herren. Amen.

*Thereafter the priest shall say, as it standeth in Matthew the sixth:* When the disciples came unto the Lord Jesus and besought him that he should teach them to pray, he said: When ye will pray, ye shall not babble much, as the hypocrites do; for they think that when they make many words they shall be heard. But say thus, as hereafter followeth: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name! Thy kingdom come unto us! Thy will be done as in heaven and in earth! Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil! Amen. *And he saith further:* O Lord, deliver us from all visible and invisible enemies, from the devil, from the world, from our own flesh; through Christ Jesus our Lord. Amen.

**Note.**

- **The introduction to the Our Father.** *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti* is replaced by Christ's own warrant (Mt 6:7; Lk 11:1). Sehling calls it an "Umgestaltung der Einleitung".
- **The embolism.** The prayer after the Our Father is what Sehling calls the "Rest des Embolismus". It keeps the *Libera nos … Domine* form and the *Per … Christum* ending. The "evils past, present and to come", the saints and the petition for peace give way to the Lutheran triad of devil, world and flesh.

#### 7.8.6 Salutation and *Agnus Dei*

> *Darnach wendt sich der priester zum volk und spricht:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Das volk:* Und mit deinem geist! *Nach dem spricht der priester:* Du lamb Gottes, das du weknimbst die sünd der welt, erbarm dich unser! Du lamb Gottes, das du weknimbst die sünd der welt, gib uns den frid!

*Thereafter the priest turneth to the people and saith:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *After that the priest saith:* O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, have mercy upon us! O thou Lamb of God, that takest away the sin of the world, give us peace!

**Note.** *Dominus vobiscum* stands where *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* stood.

#### 7.8.7 The exhortation (Osiander)

> *Nach disem wend sich der priester zum volk und spricht die exhortation, wie dann hernach volgt.* Mein allerliebsten in Got! Dieweil wir jetzo das abentessen unsers Herren Jesu Christi wöllen bedenken und halten, darin uns sein flaisch und plut zur speis und zum trank, nicht des leibs, sondern der selen gegeben wirt, söllen wir pillich mit großem vleiß ain jedlicher sich selbs prüfen, wie Paulus sagt, und alsdann von disem prot essen und von disem kelch trinken. Dann es soll nicht dann nur ain hungerige seel, die ir sünd erkennt, Gottes zorn und den tod fürcht und nach der gerechtigkait hungerig und durstig ist, dis heilig sacrament empfahen. So wir aber uns selbs prüfen, finden wir nichts in uns dann sünd und tod, kunden auch uns selbs in keinen weg daraus helfen. Darumb hat unser lieber Herr Jesus Christus sich uber uns erparmet, ist umb unsertwillen mensch worden, das er für uns das gesetz erfüllet und lide, was wir mit unsern sünden verschuldet hetten, und daß wir das je festiglich glauben und uns frölich darauf verlassen möchten, nam er nach dem abentessen das prot, saget dank, prachs und sprach: Nempt hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch dar gegeben wirt, als wölt er sagen: Daß ich mensch bin worden und alles, was ich tu und leide, das ist alles euer aigen, für euch und euch zu gut

> geschehen. Des zu gewissen warzaichen gib ich euch mein leib zur speis. Desgleichen auch den kelck und sprach: Nempt hin, und trinkt aus disem alle! Das ist der kelch des neuen testaments mit meinem plut, das für euch und für vil vergossen wirt, zur verzeihung der sünd. So oft ir das tut, solt ir mein darbei gedenken! Als wölt er sprechen: Dieweil ich mich euer angenommen, und euer sünd auf mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs für die sünde in den tod opfern, mein plut vergießen, gnad und vergebung der sünd erwerben und also ain neu testament aufrichten, darin der sünd ewig nicht soll gedacht werden. Des zum gewisen warzeichen gib ich euch mein plut zu trinken. Wer nun also von disem prot isset, und von disem kelch trinket, das ist: Wer diesen worten, die er horet, und disen zaichen, die er empfahet, festiglich glaubet, der bleibt in Christo und Christus in im und lebet also ewiglich. Darbei söllen wir an seines tods gedenken und ime darumb danksagen, ain jedlicher sein creuz auf sich nemen und ime nachfolgen und zuvor ainer den andern lieb haben, wie er auch uns geliebt hat, dann wir vil sein ain prot und ain leib, die wir alle aines prots taihaftig sein und aus ainem kelch trinken. Das verleihe uns Got allen, das wirs wirdiglich empfahen. Amen.

*After this the priest turneth to the people and saith the exhortation, as hereafter followeth.* My dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein his flesh and blood are given us for meat and for drink, not of the body but of the soul, we ought rightly with great diligence every one to examine himself, as Paul saith, and so to eat of this bread and drink of this cup. For none but a hungry soul, which knoweth its sin, feareth God's wrath and death, and is hungry and thirsty after righteousness, ought to receive this holy sacrament. But when we examine ourselves, we find nothing in us but sin and death, and could in no wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sakes is become man, that he might fulfil the law for us and suffer that which we had deserved with our sins. And that we might steadfastly believe this and joyfully rely thereupon, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; as if he would say: That I am become man, and all that I do and suffer, that is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token thereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament with my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby! As if he would say: Forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sin shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token thereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, that is, whosoever firmly believeth these words which he heareth and these signs which he receiveth, he dwelleth in Christ and Christ in him, and so liveth for ever. Hereby shall we remember his death and give him thanks therefor, every one take up his cross and follow him, and above all love one another, as he also hath loved us; for we being many are one bread and one body, who are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup. God grant us all this, that we may receive it worthily. Amen.

**Note.** Sehling does not reprint the text here. He points to the order of the parish churches of 1524 (Sehling 11, I.5, p. 48), whose base text is **Osiander's** exhortation from the provosts' *Grundt und ursach* (1524).

The text above is that base text with **Döber's readings (Sehling's siglum D)** taken from his apparatus:

- *Mein allerliebsten*;
- *kunden auch uns selbs in keinen weg*;
- *das er für uns*;
- *zur verzeihung*;
- *ewig nicht soll gedacht*;
- *zum gewisen warzeichen*;
- *in Christo* without *dem Herren*;
- *lieb haben*;
- the closing sentence *Das verleihe uns Got allen …*, which p. 54 confirms.

One point is uncertain. For "Des zu [ainem] gewissen warzaichen" (the bread) the apparatus is garbled; it seems to say D lacks *ainem*.

In Nürnberg this exhortation stood where the Latin Verba had been read silently. Once the Verba were sung aloud in German, Sehling notes, the exhortation "doubled" them.

#### 7.8.8 *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi*, said by the people

> *Nach diser exhortation wendt sich der priester zum altar und spricht zum volk: Sprecht mir nach:* O Herr Jesu Christe, du ewigs wort des Vaters, du Heiland der welt, du warer, lebendiger Got und mensch, erlöse uns durch deinen heiligen fronleichnam und rosenfarbes blut von allen sünden! Hilf, das wir erfüllen deine gebot zu allen zeiten und von dir nicht gescheiden werden in ewigkeit! Amen.

*After this exhortation the priest turneth to the altar and saith to the people: Say after me:* O Lord Jesus Christ, thou eternal Word of the Father, thou Saviour of the world, thou true, living God and man, deliver us by thy holy body and rose-red blood from all sins! Help that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and be not separated from thee for ever! Amen.

**Note.** This is *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi, qui ex voluntate Patris, cooperante Spiritu Sancto, per mortem tuam mundum vivificasti: libera me per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum ab omnibus iniquitatibus meis, et universis malis: et fac me tuis semper inhaerere mandatis, et a te numquam separari permittas*. Sehling calls it "leicht umgestaltet", as in Volprecht's Mass.

- **Opening.** The Trinitarian opening is replaced by titles of Christ.
- **Number and speaker.** *Me* becomes *uns*.
- **Words for body and blood.** *Fronleichnam* is the old word for the Lord's body (as in *Fronleichnamsfest*, Corpus Christi). *Rosenfarbes blut* is a late-medieval devotional epithet.
- **Who says it.** The priest's private preparation before his communion is now said by the people after him.

#### 7.8.9 Communion

> *Nun communicirt er das volk von ersten, ob er will, und so er in den leib Christi darreicht, spricht er zu in:* Der leib Christi bewar dein seel zum ewigen leben! *Desgleichen spricht er auch, wenn ers nimbt. Und darnach nimbt er den kelch und spricht:* Das blut unsers lieben Herren Jesu Christi, das für mich und für euch vergossen ist in vergebung der sünde, bewar mein seel zum ewigen leben! *Und wenn er sumirt hat, bind er den kelch ein.*

*Now he communicateth the people first, if he will; and when he reacheth them the body of Christ, he saith unto them:* The body of Christ preserve thy soul unto everlasting life! *The same he saith also when he taketh it himself. And thereafter he taketh the cup and saith:* The blood of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, which is shed for me and for you unto the forgiveness of sins, preserve my soul unto everlasting life! *And when he hath consumed, he bindeth up the cup.*

**Note.** These are *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam tuam in vitam aeternam* and the priest's *Sanguis Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam …*, with "das für mich und für euch vergossen ist in vergebung der sünde" added.

"Bind er den kelch ein" means he wraps the chalice in its bag.

#### 7.8.10 *Nunc dimittis*, postcommunion, dismissal and blessing

> *Nach demselben spricht er zum volk: Sprecht mir nach:* O Herr, nun laß im frid deinen diener nach deinem wort; dann unsere augen haben gesehen deinen heiland, welchen du bereitet hast vor dem angesicht aller völker, ein licht, zu erleuchten die heiden und zu einer glori deines volks Israhel. Dir sei lob, ehr und dank, o du heilige, gebenedeite, herliche Dreifeldigkeit, Got Vater, Got Sun und Heiliger Geist! Amen. *Nach disem kert sich der priester zu dem volk und spricht also:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Das volk:* Und mit deinem geist! *Darnach die collecten spricht zum volk:* Last uns bitten: O Herr, allmechtiger Got, verleih uns in unser gemüt und herzen, das wir durch den zeitlichen tod deines Suns, welche dise wirdige geheimnus bedeuten, das wir getrauen, das du uns geben hast das ewig leben durch den Christum, unsern Herrn. Amen. *Zu dem letzten kert er sich umb zum volk und spricht:* Der Herr sei mit euch! *Das volk:* Und mit deinem geist! *Der priester:* Saget dank dem Herren! *Das volk:* Got sei lob und dank! *Der priester:* Neigt eur herz zu Got, so will ich euch den segen geben! *Und spricht:* Der Herr gebenedei dich und behüt dich und erleucht sein angesicht über dich und erbarm sich dein und wend sein angesicht zu dir und geb dir den ewigen frid im namen des Vaters und Suns und des Heiligen Geists! Amen. Gehet hin im frid des Herren! *Nun gehet der priester hinweg vom altar.* So habt ir das end diser evangelische meß. Got wöl uns verleihen, was uns nütz sei zu seel und leib! Amen.

*After the same he saith to the people: Say after me:* O Lord, now let thy servant depart in peace according to thy word; for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all peoples, a light to lighten the Gentiles and to be the glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise, honour and thanks, O thou holy, blessed, glorious Trinity, God the Father, God the Son and Holy Ghost! Amen. *After this the priest turneth to the people and saith thus:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *Thereafter he saith the collect to the people:* Let us pray: O Lord, almighty God, grant unto us in our mind and

heart that, through the temporal death of thy Son, which these worthy mysteries signify, we may trust that thou hast given us everlasting life; through the Christ our Lord. Amen. *Last of all he turneth about to the people and saith:* The Lord be with you! *The people:* And with thy spirit! *The priest:* Give thanks unto the Lord! *The people:* God be praise and thanks! *The priest:* Incline your hearts unto God, and I will give you the blessing! *And he saith:* The Lord bless thee and keep thee, and lighten his countenance upon thee, and have mercy upon thee, and turn his countenance unto thee, and give thee everlasting peace; in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost! Amen. Go ye in the peace of the Lord! *Now the priest goeth away from the altar.* So have ye the end of this evangelical Mass. God grant us that which is profitable for soul and body! Amen.

**Note.**

- **The collect.** It follows the Roman postcommunion of Wednesday in Holy Week: *Largire sensibus nostris, omnipotens Deus: ut per temporalem Filii tui mortem, quam mysteria veneranda testantur, vitam te nobis dedisse perpetuam confidamus*. Sehling calls it "anscheinend neu geschaffen"; the Roman source is identified here for the first time. Note that *testantur* ("bear witness to") is rendered *bedeuten*.
- **The dismissal.** "Saget dank dem Herren … Got sei lob und dank" answers to *Benedicamus Domino / Deo gratias*. Sehling reads "Gehet hin im frid des Herren" as a paraphrase of *Ite, missa est*.

### 7.8.11 Optional intercession in the place of *Te igitur*

> *Es volgt ein gemein gebet, an einem feiertag zu sprechen, wenn vil volks da ist, nach der prefation oder für das Sanctus, wie man wil.* Almechtiger, ewiger Got und barmherziger Vater. Dieweil dein Sun, unser Herr Jesus Christus, zugesagt hat, was wir bitten in seinem namen, das werdestu uns gewehren, und zu dem, dieweil dein Geist auch bevohlen hat, das wir für unser oberigkeit bitten sollen, bitten wir von herzen, du wöllest die gemüter des kaisers, der fürsten und herrn, vorab unser herren und öbern ains ersamen rats zu erkantnus deiner güte und des evangelions bewegen, auch das du deinem Sun durch den Hailigen Gaist undertenig machest alle völker, auf das si selbs willig sein verheißung erkennen, annemen und behüten, und vorab diser gemein verleihe, das si zuneme in erkantnus des evangelions und seines süßen jochs und gemachsamen bürden. Diweil nu, almechtiger, ewiger Got, geliebter und barmherziger Vater, dein ainiger Sun, unser Herr Jesus, in die welt kumen ist zu ainem arzt der kranken und nit der gesunden und aber unser blindheit die gegenwertige schand der sunden durch sich selbs nit sehen noch für krankhait erkennen mag, dann wir leider vergift sind und in unser irrung und übertretung uns selbs gefallen, die gebot Gottes hassen, die laster lieben, so biten wir, du wöllest durch Got den Heiligen Geist dein gesatz in unser herzen schreiben und die verborgen sünd in uns lebendig machen und also uns verleihen, das wir brüfen und empfinden mögen, wie unmüglich es uns ist, guts zu tun, damit wir ein hunger und durst gewinnen zu der genaden und gerechtigkait, so vor dir allein gilt, welche du der welt geben hast durch Christum Jesum unsern Herren. *Nach disem volgt das Qui pridie. Gott sei lob!*

*There followeth a common prayer, to be said on a feast day when much people is present, after the Preface or before the Sanctus, as one will.* Almighty, everlasting God and merciful Father: forasmuch as thy Son our Lord Jesus Christ hath promised that whatsoever we ask in his name, thou wilt grant it us; and moreover, forasmuch as thy Spirit also hath commanded that we should pray for our magistrates: we beseech thee from our hearts that thou wouldest move the minds of the emperor, the princes and lords, and above all of our lords and superiors of an honourable council, unto the knowledge of thy goodness and of the Gospel; and also that thou wouldest make all peoples subject unto thy Son through the Holy Ghost, that they themselves may willingly acknowledge, receive and keep his promise; and above all grant unto this congregation that it may increase in the knowledge of the Gospel, and of his sweet yoke and easy burden. Forasmuch now, almighty, everlasting God, beloved and merciful Father, as thine only Son our Lord Jesus is come into the world to be a physician of the sick and not of the whole, and yet our blindness cannot of itself see the present shame of sin nor know it for a sickness, for we are, alas, poisoned, and please ourselves in our error and transgression, hate the commandments of God and love vices: we pray thee that thou wouldest, through God the Holy Ghost, write thy law in our hearts and make the hidden sin alive in us, and so grant us that we may prove and perceive how impossible it is for us to do good; that we may gain a hunger and thirst after the grace and righteousness which alone availeth before thee, which thou hast given to the world through Christ Jesus our Lord. *After this followeth the Qui pridie. God be praised!*

**Note.** Sehling traces the prayer to the Strasbourg order of 1524 (Moderate Reformed). Its rubric puts it exactly where *Te igitur* stood: after the Preface, before the Sanctus in Döber's order, and leading into *Qui pridie*. It intercedes for the emperor, princes and council, for all peoples, and for "this congregation". These are the intentions of *Te igitur* and the *Memento*, turned into an evangelical prayer for faith and for the knowledge of sin.

## 7.9 Bremen, *Eyne evangelysce Misse*, 1525 (Kantz in Low German)

*Eyne evangelysce Misse myt etlijke schone gebede* … Bremen 1525. Sehling 7, III, Nr. 1, pp. 403–407 (eko.db doc 2216).

The Mass itself is Kantz's order of 1522 (§7.2) in Low German. Before it stand three devotional prayers for the communicant. The second is a "betrachtinge by der Misse", a meditation during Mass. Its opening confession of the Real Presence is the nearest thing in the order to a Canon.

The foreword warns that the prayers are no rule: they are meant to show "what faith and desire are needed to receive the testament of Christ in a Christian manner".

### 7.9.1 The meditation during Mass

> *Eyn betrachtinge by der Misse* Almechtige, ewige Got, mijn here Jesu Christe, Ick gelove, dat in dussem brode jegenwordich sy dijn hillige ware licham unde in dussem wijne dijn durbar blot angenamen hefst, um Adam unde al syne nakomelinge to verlosen van den ewigen dode. Unde heft uns gelaten in dussem hochwerdigen Sacramente eyn seker, wisse teken dijner waraftiger beloftenisse, de sunden to vergeven, dat dijne worde betugen, de in der Missen gesproken werden: Nemet hen unde etet. Dat is mijn licham, dat voer iw gegeven wert. Nemet hen unde drincket dar alle af. Dit is mijn bloet, dat vor iw vergaten wert to vergevinge der sunden. Up sulken trosteliken toseggen begere ick wt mynen gantsen herten, in rechter tovorsicht unde guden vortruwen, dat du my nicht latest leddich unde hongerich ungespiset van hier gan, sunder spisen wilst unde laven myt dijn levendige woert, Welker uns vercundiget vergevinge unser sunden dorch dyn licham unde bloet, Uppe dat ick in warer liften jegen dy unde broderlike trwe jegen mynen nechsten bevestiget mach werden.

*A meditation at the Mass* Almighty, everlasting God, my Lord Jesu Christ, I believe that in this bread is present thy holy true body, and in this wine thy precious blood, which thou hast taken upon thee to redeem Adam and all his posterity from everlasting death. And thou hast left us in this most worthy Sacrament a sure and certain sign of thy true promise to forgive sins, which thy words witness that are spoken in the Mass: Take and eat. This is my body, which is given for you. Take and drink ye all thereof. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. Upon such comfortable promise I desire from my whole heart, in right confidence and good trust, that thou let me not go hence empty and hungry, unfed, but wilt feed and refresh me with thy living word, which proclaimeth unto us the forgiveness of our sins through thy body and blood; that I may be established in true love toward thee and brotherly faithfulness toward my neighbour.

**Note.**

- **Who is addressed.** The prayer is addressed to Christ as "Almechtige, ewige Got" and confesses the Real Presence "in dussem brode … in dussem wijne".
- **The Verba** are quoted from "the words spoken in the Mass": the priest's words are now heard by the congregation.
- **The Roman background.** It is the priest's private preparation for communion, of the kind in the late-medieval *Praeparatio ad missam*, given to the laity.

### 7.9.2 The Mass: preparation

The preparation follows Kantz (§7.2.1–7.2.2) closely:

- the exhortation "Alderlevesten in Christo, Uppe dat gy myt vroliken unde begerliken herten entfangen mogen den kosteliken schat unde dat testamente des vlesches unde blodes Christi Jesu …";
- the absolution;
- "Bicht des presters", the recast *Orate fratres*: "biddet oeck Got trwelick vor my, dat he my mijne sunden vergevende, bequeme make iw syn tekene to delen" ("that he … make me meet to distribute his signs to you");
- Ps 124:8;
- the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* antiphon, said "hemelick" by all;
- Kantz's collect, "O Here, almechtige Got, help, dat by uns sy unde wane dyn hillige geist …".

### 7.9.3 Preface, Sanctus, *Quam oblationem* and *Qui pridie*

> *Prefacio ofte vorrede der Missen* Vorhevet iw herten to Gade unde latet uns danckseggen Gade, unsen heren. Went et is billick, recht unde heilsam, dat wy in allen orden unde to aller tyt dy here, hillige vader, almechtige, ewige Got, danckseggen dorck Christum, unsen leven heren, Dorch welken alle engelen unde hemmelsche crachte anbeden, eren unde laven dyne hillige maiesteit. Myt den sulvigen bidden wy, wilt to laten unde annemen unse stemme, dat wy dy oeck laven unde spreken sunder ende: Sanctus: Dat is: Hillige, Hillige, Hillige, here Got der herscaren. Vul synt hemmel unde erde dijner herlicheit. Osanna in den hogesten. Gebenediet sy, de dar kumpt in den name des heren. Gelucke unde heil in den hogesten. *Hier hevet sick erst de Evangelische Misse an Eyn gebeth vor an to Gade* O Alder guedigeste vader, barmhertige, ewige Got, giff uns, dat wy vast geloven, dat dit brot unde wijn wert dat waraftige lijf unde blot dijnes alder levesten sonnes, unses heren Jesu Christi, Welcker an deme dage vor synem lijdent nam dat brot in sijne hilligen hande, sach up to dem hemmel to dy, synem almechtigen vader, sede danck unde brack dat brot unde gaf dat synen jungeren, sprekende: Nemet hen unde etet, dat is mijn licham, dat vor iuw gegeven wert. Des gelijken, na dem aventmal, nam he den kellick in syne hillige hande, danckede synen vader unde gaf synen jungeren unde sprak: Nemet hen unde drincket alle daruth, dat is de kellick des nijgen unde ewigen testamentes in mijnen blode, dat vor iuw unde vor vele vorgaten wert to vorgevinge der sunden. So vaken alse gy dat doet, so doet dat in mijne gedechtenisse.

*The Preface, or foreword of the Mass* Lift up your hearts to God, and let us give thanks unto God our Lord. For it is meet, right and wholesome that we should in all places and at all times give thanks unto thee, O Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, through Christ our dear Lord, through whom all angels and heavenly powers worship, honour and praise thy holy majesty. With the same we beseech thee, vouchsafe to admit and receive our voice, that we also may praise thee and say without end: Sanctus: That is: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God of hosts. Full are heaven and earth of thy glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Luck and salvation in the highest. *Here beginneth first the Evangelical Mass A prayer to God beforehand* O most gracious Father, merciful, everlasting God, grant us that we may firmly believe that this bread and wine becometh the true body and blood of thy most dear Son, our Lord Jesus Christ; who on the day before his passion took the bread into his holy hands, looked up to heaven unto thee, his almighty Father, gave thanks, and brake the bread, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you. Likewise, after the supper, he took the cup into his holy hands, thanked his Father, and gave it to his disciples, and spake: Take and drink ye all thereout, this is the cup of the new and everlasting testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, do it in my remembrance.

**Note.**

- **The recast *Quam oblationem*.** Sehling's note: "Dieses Gebet entspricht weitgehend dem Gebet *Quam oblationem* des Missale Romanum". Kantz's petition "hilf, das dises brot und der wein uns werde und sei …" (*ut nobis … fiat*) has become "giff uns, dat wy vast geloven, dat dit brot unde wijn wert …". The prayer no longer asks that the bread become the body. It asks that we believe that it does.
- **The Verba.** Kantz's two *benedixit* ("segnet") are dropped.

#### 7.9.4 Our Father, *Agnus Dei*, *Fili Dei vivi*, communion, *Nunc dimittis*

> Lat uns bidden: Unse vader, de du bist in den hemmel. Gehilget werde dijn name. Tokamen sy uns dijn ryke. Dijn wille de gesche alse in den hemmel, so oeck up der erden. Unse dagelikes brot gif uns huden. Unde vorgif uns unse schult, alse wy vorgeven unse schuldeneren. Unde vore uns nicht in vorsokinge, Sunder vorlose uns van allen quaden. Dorch unsen heren, Jesum Christum, dijnen sone, de myt dy unde dem hilligen geiste, eyn war Got, levet unde regneret in ewicheit. *Agnus Dei* O du lam Gades, de du dregest de sunde der welt, vorbarme dy unser unde gif uns dijnen vrede. *Eyn gebet vor der entfanginge des hochwerdigen Sacramentes* O Here Jesu Christe, du ewige wort dijnes vaders, Du heilant der werlt, levendig Got, vorlose uns dorch dijne grondelose barmherticheit van allen sunden. Help, dat wy vorvullen dijne gebade to aller tijdt unde van dy nicht gescheden werden in ewicheit. *Hier na scal de priester dat hochwerdige Sacrament geven den, de dat myt eynen hungerigen, sundigen herten begerent, also sprekende:* Wes getrostet. Wente siet, dit is dat licham unses heren Jesu Christi, dat vor iw geleden heft den bitteren doet. Nemet hen unde etet, uppe dattet iw spise unde beware in dat ewige levent. *Alse se alle berichtet synt myt den licham Christi, so scal de prester nemen den kellick myt den durbar blode Christi unde spreken also:* Nu wil wy oeck drincken den kelick des heils unde anropen den namen des heren. Siet, gy bedrofde, sundige herten, unde weset getrostet. Wente dit is de durbar, kostelike scat des blodes uns heren Jesu Christi, darmede gij gekoft sint. Nemet dit unde delet under malkanderen to afwasschinge iwer sunden. *Went dit alles geschen is, so scal de prester myt der gantzer Christen gemene dancken unde laven den heren myt dussen lavesanck seggende:* O Here, nu latet in vrede dijnen knecht na dijnen worden, want unse ogen hebben gesien dijnen heilant, den

> du bereidet hefst voer den angesichte alles volckes, Eyn lecht, to vorluchtende de heiden unde to eyner glorie dijnes volkes Ysrahel. Dy sy lof unde danck, o du hillige, benedide drevoldicheit, Got vader, sonne, hillige geist.

Let us pray: Our Father, which art in heaven. Hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come unto us. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so also on earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debt, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from all evil. Through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever. *Agnus Dei* O thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us and give us thy peace. *A prayer before the receiving of the most worthy Sacrament* O Lord Jesu Christ, thou everlasting Word of thy Father, thou Saviour of the world, living God, deliver us through thy bottomless mercy from all sins. Help us that we may fulfil thy commandments at all times, and never be parted from thee for ever. *Hereafter shall the priest give the most worthy Sacrament to them that desire it with a hungry, sinful heart, saying thus:* Be comforted. For behold, this is the body of our Lord Jesus Christ, which suffered for you the bitter death. Take and eat, that it may feed you and preserve you unto everlasting life. *When they have all been communicated with the body of Christ, the priest shall take the cup with the precious blood of Christ, and say thus:* Now will we also drink the cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord. Behold, ye troubled, sinful hearts, and be comforted. For this is the precious, costly treasure of the blood of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherewith ye are bought. Take this and divide it among yourselves to the washing away of your sins. *When all this is done, the priest shall with the whole Christian congregation thank and praise the Lord with this song of praise, saying:* O Lord, now let thy servant depart in peace according to thy words, for our eyes have seen thy salvation, which thou hast prepared before the face of all people, a light to lighten the Gentiles and for a glory of thy people Israel. To thee be praise and thanks, O thou holy, blessed Trinity, God the Father, Son, Holy Ghost.

**Note.**

- **As in Kantz (§7.2.5–7.2.7):**
  - the conclusion of the embolism after the Our Father;
  - one *Agnus Dei*;
  - an abridged *Fili Dei vivi*;
  - the *custodiat* ("spise unde beware in dat ewige levent");
  - *Calicem salutaris*;
  - the *Nunc dimittis* with a Trinitarian doxology.
- **What changes from Kantz:**
  - ***Fili Dei vivi.*** Kantz's "erlös uns durch disen deinen heiligen fronleichnam und rosenvarbes blut" (*per hoc sacrosanctum Corpus et Sanguinem tuum*) becomes "dorch dijne grondelose barmherticheit". Bremen removes the one phrase that ascribed the deliverance to the consecrated elements.
  - **The communicants** are "de dat myt eynen hungerigen, sundigen herten begerent".
  - **Omitted.** The showing of the host and the *Pax* are gone. No fraction, as in Kantz's first edition.
- **What follows.** A German *Te Deum*.

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## 7.10 Lippe, *Deutsche Messe*, [1525–1538] (Müntzer in Low German)

Sehling 22, IX (Lippe, Nachtrag), Nr. 1, pp. 565–569 (`eko.db` doc 1549). It is a manuscript Mass with notes, for Trinity Sunday.

Its eucharistic part is Müntzer's German Mass (§7.4; Radical Reformation) in Low German, taken into a Lutheran order:

- the *Per omnia saecula* before the Preface;
- the Roman *Qui pridie* with "hoff up syne ogen" and "eyn gheheymnys des ghelavens";
- "Darumme ladt uns alle bydden als uns Jhesus Christus … heyfft gheleret";
- the *Per omnia saecula* after the Our Father;
- *Pax Domini*.

Its propers are those of Volprecht's Trinity Mass (§7.7.2): Rom 11:33–36, John 15:26–16:4, the Alleluia *Benedictus es, Domine, Deus patrum nostrorum*, and the *Proficiat* postcommunion.

Müntzer's own German Mass has no Trinity Mass. The Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1525, which reprinted Müntzer's Masses, added one (Sehling 6, III, p. 812 n. 26, to Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, §7.13). An Erfurt print of this kind is the likely source of the Lippe text.

> *Dat offertorium Vor dat offertorium synget me eyn geystlick leidt, dat ys eyn psalme. Prefatio* Durch alle ewicheit der ewicheit amen. De here sy myt iw. Und myt dynem geiste. Unse herten yn de hoge. Hebben wy tho dem heren. Wy seggen danck dem heren, unserem Gade. Edt ys byllyck unde recht. Warlyck, edt is byllick unde recht, dartho ock yst seer heilsam, dat wy dy altydt und yn allen enden danck seggen. Here, heillyge vader, almechtige, ewyge Godt, welcker du myt dynem eyngebornen soen und dem hilligen geiste eyn enyge Godt bist, eyn enyger here bist. Nicht yn eynycheit der personen, sonder yn der enycheit eynes sunderliken wesens. Den dat wy durch dyn sulvest apenbarynge von dyner herlicheit gheloven, even dat sulffte holden wy underscheiden van dynem sone und dem hilligen geiste, up dat yn der bekentnysse der waren und ewyghen godtheit de eghenschop yn den personen und enyccheit [!] yn dem wesen und de ghelicheit yn der majestat recht werde anghebetet, welke de engel laven, erwerdigen de ertzeengel, dartho Cherubin und Seraphin, de ane unterladt myt eyndrechtiger stemmen syngen: Heillich, hyllich, hillich bist her Godt der herscharen, hymmel und erde syndt vorfullet myt dynem prise. Ach, help uns, de du byst yn den hochsten. Ghesegnet sy, de dar kumpt ym namen des heren. Ach gyff gheluck und heyl yn den hochsten.

*The offertory For the offertory a spiritual song is sung, that is, a psalm. The Preface* World without end. Amen. The Lord be with you. And with thy spirit. Our hearts on high. We have them unto the Lord. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. It is meet and right. Verily it is meet and right, and moreover very wholesome, that we should always and in all places give thanks unto thee, Lord, holy Father, almighty, everlasting God, who with thine only-begotten Son and the Holy Ghost art one only God, art one only Lord; not in the oneness of a person, but in the oneness of a single being. For that which by thine own revelation we believe of thy glory, even the same we hold, without difference, of thy Son and of the Holy Ghost; that in the confession of the true and everlasting Godhead, the propriety in the persons and the unity in the being and the equality in the majesty may be rightly worshipped; which the angels praise, the archangels honour, and thereto Cherubim and Seraphim, who without ceasing sing with one accord of voice: Holy, holy, holy art thou, Lord God of hosts, heaven and earth are filled with thy praise. Ah, help us, thou that art in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Ah, give luck and salvation in the highest.

**Note.**

- **The offertory.** It keeps its name and its place, as a German hymn.
- **"Durch alle ewicheit der ewicheit amen"** heads the "Prefatio". It is the *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen* that ended the silent Secret, as in Müntzer (§7.4.1).
- **The Preface** is the Trinity Preface, rendered fully:
  - *Qui cum unigenito Filio tuo et Spiritu Sancto unus es Deus, unus es Dominus: non in unius singularitate personae, sed in unius Trinitate substantiae …;*
  - *… et in personis proprietas, et in essentia unitas, et in maiestate adoretur aequalitas. Quam laudant Angeli atque Archangeli, Cherubim quoque ac Seraphim ….*

  "In der enycheit eynes sunderliken wesens" renders *in unius Trinitate substantiae* loosely.
- **The Sanctus.** "Ach, help uns" is *Hosanna*.

> Eynen dach thovoren, do Jhesus wolde lyden, nam he dat brodt yn syne hilligen hende und hoff up syne ogen yn den hemmel tho dy, Godt, synem almechtigen vader, und sachte dy danck und segende dat und brack dat und gaff dat synen jungeren, seggende: Nemet hen und ethet darvan, dat ys myn lichnam, de vor iw dar gegeven wert. *Hyr ghyfft he den luden dat sacrament, de syk willen berichten laten. Darna nympt he den kelck in de handt und spreckt:* Des sulven gheliken, als me ghetten hadde, nam he den kelck yn syne hilligen, werdigen hende und sachte dy danck und seghende en und gaff en synen jüngeren, seggende: Nempt hen und dryncket all dar uth. Dat ys de kelck mynes blodes, des nyggen und ewygen bundes, eyn gheheymnys des ghelavens, de vor iw und vor viel vorgatten wert yn vorgevynge der sunde. Also vaken gy dat doen, so schol ghy myner darby gedencken. *Hyr ghyfft he den lüden, de syk berichten laten, ok den kelck, under des synget me dat leydt: Godt sy gelavet edder: Jhesus Christus unse heylandt edder dat düdesche sanctus.*

The day before, when Jesus would suffer, he took the bread into his holy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat thereof, this is my body, which is given for you. *Here he giveth the sacrament to the people who will be communicated. Thereafter he taketh the cup in his hand and saith:* In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all thereout. This is the cup of

my blood, of the new and everlasting covenant, a mystery of faith, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. *Here he giveth the people who are communicated the cup also; meanwhile the hymn "Gott sei gelobet" is sung, or "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", or the German Sanctus.*

**Note.**

- **The Verba** are word for word Müntzer's *Qui pridie* (§7.4.2), with *mysterium fidei*.
- **The order of communion.** As Luther proposed in the *Deutsche Messe*, the bread is given after the bread-word and the cup after the cup-word. So the Our Father, the *Pax* and the *Agnus Dei* come *after* communion.

> Darumme ladt uns alle bydden als uns Jhesus Christus, de sone Gades, heyfft gheleret, seggende: Wader unse, de du byst yn den hemmelen, ghehylliget werde dyn name, tho kame dyn rike. Dyn wylle ghesche up erden alse ym hemmel. Unse dachlike brodt gyff uns hute und vorgyff uns unse schuldt, als wy vorgeven unsen schuldeners, und vore uns nicht yn vorsokynge, sonder vorlose uns van dem ovel, amen. Dat ghesche dorch unsen heren Jhesum Christum, dynen soen, welker myt dy und dem hyllighen geiste eyn waer Godt, levet und herschet yn ewicheit, amen. Durch alle ewycheit der ewicheit amen. De fryde des heren sy altydt myt iwe und myt dynem geiste. O laem Gades, de du dregst de sunde der werlt, erbarm dick unser. O lam Gades, de du dregst de sunde der werlt, gyff uns dynen frede. *Dat commun Vor dat commun synget me eynen psalme edder geistlick lavesanck. Darna sprickt de pharher tho dem volcke:* De here sy myt iw. *Antwert:* Unde myt dynem geiste. O here Godt, ladt uns tho nütte komen des lyves unde der seelen, de entfangynge des hyllighen Sacramentes und de ewighe bekentnysse der hillyghen und der sulffstendigen unghedeilden dreyvoldycheit, de du levest und regerest eyn enych Godt dorch alle ewicheit thor ewicheit, amen. Ladt uns benedyen den hern, Gade sy ewich danck. De here benedye dy unde behode dy unde erluchte syn anghesichte aver dy unde erbarme syck dyner unde wende syn anghesichte tho dy unde gheve dy den frede, amen.

Therefore let us all pray, as Jesus Christ, the Son of God, hath taught us, saying: Our Father, which art in the heavens, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come. Thy will be done on earth as in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debt, as we forgive our debtors, and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil, amen. This be done through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee and the Holy Ghost, one true God, liveth and reigneth for ever, amen. World without end. Amen. The peace of the Lord be alway with you, and with thy spirit. O Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, give us thy peace. *The communion For the communion a psalm or spiritual song of praise is sung. Thereafter the pastor saith to the people:* The Lord be with you. *Answer:* And with thy spirit. O Lord God, let the receiving of the holy Sacrament, and the everlasting confession of the holy and self-subsistent undivided Trinity, profit us for body and soul; who livest and reignest one only God, world without end, amen. Let us bless the Lord; thanks be to God for ever. The Lord bless thee and keep thee, and make his face shine upon thee, and have mercy upon thee, and turn his face unto thee and give thee peace, amen.

**Note.**

- **The embolism's two endings.** Lippe has both:
  - Kantz's "Dat ghesche dorch unsen heren …", the conclusion *Per eundem Dominum*;
  - Müntzer's "Durch alle ewycheit der ewicheit", the chant ending *Per omnia saecula*.

  There is no fraction rubric.
- ***Pax Domini*** is kept with its response. The response is run on in the manuscript.
- **The postcommunion** is the Roman *Proficiat* of Trinity Sunday, as in Volprecht (§7.7.2).
- **The blessing.** "Ladt uns benedyen den hern, Gade sy ewich danck" is Müntzer's *Benedicamus*. The Aaronic blessing follows.

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## 7.11 Schleswig-Holstein, a Low German Mass from Kiel, [after 1526]

Sehling 23, A, Nr. 1, pp. 55–57 (`eko.db` doc 1576; introduction in doc 1568, p. 39). The manuscript, with notes, was bound into a book of the Kiel preacher Rudolf von Nimwegen († 1542). Sehling's editor dates it after 1526 because it draws on Döber (1525) and on Luther's *Deutsche Messe* (1526).

The order also draws on:

- **Kantz** (§7.2): the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* and its collect.
- **Müntzer** (§7.4): the Roman *Qui pridie*, with "hoff up syne ogen".
- **Döber** (§7.8): the *Fili Dei vivi* said by the people after the priest.

It is the only order in the corpus with a German *Domine, non sum dignus*.

#### 7.11.1 Before the altar: absolution by the sexton, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, collect

> *Minister legit: Myseriator. De coster list: Miseriator.* De almechtyge, barmhartyge Got vorgeve uns unße sunde. Unde yck, uth bevele unßes heren Jesu Christi, segge jwe, de gy Gades gnaden truwen unde loven synen worden, frigh, leddich unde loß alle jwe sunde. Im name des vaders unde des sones unde des hylgen geistes. *De prester:* Amen. *De prester lyst:* Kum, hilge geist, erfülle de hartenn dyner gelovygen unde entfenge in en dat vor dyner gotliken leve, de du dorch menychfoldycheyt der tungenn de volcker der gantzenn warldet vorsamelt heffst in enycheit des waren gelovens. *Costos:* Amen. *De prester list:* O here, almechtige Got, gyff, dat by uns sy unde wane dyne hilge geist, dat he uns erluchte unde lere alle warheyt. Sterke unde boschutte yn aller wedderwardicheyt, dorch Christum, unsen herren. *De coster:* Amen.

*The minister readeth: Misereatur. The sexton readeth: Misereatur.* The almighty, merciful God forgive us our sins. And I, by the commandment of our Lord Jesus Christ, say unto you that trust in God's grace and believe his words, free, quit and loosed of all your sins. In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. *The priest:* Amen. *The priest readeth:* Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love, who through the diversity of tongues hast gathered the peoples of the whole world in the unity of the true faith. *Sexton:* Amen. *The priest readeth:* O Lord, almighty God, grant that thy Holy Ghost may be and dwell with us, that he may enlighten us and teach all truth. Strengthen and defend in all adversity; through Christ our Lord. *The sexton:* Amen.

**Note.**

- **The absolution.** "Myseriator" (*Misereatur*) and the absolution are Kantz's (§7.2.1), but read by the sexton. The priest only adds the *Amen*. Sehling's editor points to Hadeln 1526 for the same practice.
- **The prayers.** The antiphon and collect are Kantz's (§7.2.2), said before the priest goes to the altar. Then the antiphon is sung again, with notes, and a troped Kyrie follows.

#### 7.11.2 Preface and the bread-word

> De Here sy myt jw. Unße harte yn de hogde. Wy seggen danck dem heren, unßem Gade. Warlich, ydt ys werdich unde recht, billich unde ys heilsam, dat wy, Here, almechtyge Godt, dy allenthalven danck seggen, unde sunderliken yn desser tydt tho pryßenn, wente Cristus, unse paschelam, ys vor uns geoffert. He ys dat wäre lam Gades, welk darwech genamen hefft de ßunde der werlde, de dorch synen tytliken dot unsen ewygen dot vorstoret hefft. Unde als he upgestan ys, hefft he wedder gebracht dat levent. Eyne dach to voren, do Jesus Christus wolde liden, nam he dat brot yn syne hillygen, werdigen hende unde hoff up syne ogen in den hemmel tho dy, Got, synem alemechtigen vader, unde ßede dy dank unde gesegende ydt unde brack dat unde gaff yt synen jüngeren, seggende: Nemet hen unde ethet alle darvan. Dyt ys myn licham, de dar vor jw gegeven verth in vorgevinge der sunde. *Nu hevet dat cor an to syngende: Jhesus Christus, unse hylant. Eyn versch dar van.*

The Lord be with you. Our hearts on high. We give thanks unto the Lord our God. Verily it is worthy and right, meet and wholesome, that we, O Lord, almighty God, should in all places give thanks unto thee, and specially at this time praise thee, for Christ our Passover lamb is offered for us. He is the true Lamb of God, which hath taken away the sin of the world, who by his temporal death hath destroyed our eternal death; and when he rose again, he hath brought life again. The day before, when Jesus Christ would suffer, he took the bread into his holy and worthy hands, and lifted up his eyes to heaven unto thee, God, his almighty Father, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and eat ye all thereof. This is my body, which is given for you for the forgiveness of sins. *Now the choir beginneth to sing: "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland". One verse thereof.*

**Note.**

- **The Preface** is the Easter Preface: *Te quidem, Domine, omni tempore, sed in hac potissimum die gloriosius praedicare, cum Pascha nostrum immolatus est Christus. Ipse enim verus est Agnus, qui abstulit peccata mundi. Qui mortem nostram moriendo destruxit, et vitam resurgendo reparavit.*
  - The manuscript breaks off before the *Et ideo* and the Sanctus (Sehling: "Der Text bricht an dieser Stelle ab").
  - "Ys vor uns geoffert" keeps *immolatus est* (1 Cor 5:7).
- **The bread-word** is Müntzer's *Qui pridie*, with "in vorgevinge der sunde" added to the bread.
- **Separate consecration.** Only the bread is consecrated now. The cup is consecrated after the communion of the bread (§7.11.4), as Luther had suggested.

### 7.11.3 Exhortation, *Fili Dei vivi, Domine non sum dignus*

> *Dar na kert sick de prester myt dem licham Cristi thom volchke. Unde de communicanten setten syck al up de reghe vor dat altar, dat sacramente tho entfangende. Unde de prester deyt eyn vormanynge unde secht, den licham Christi yn der hant haldende:* Goden frunde, Cristus, unser heylant, hefft uns in synem latesten affschede nagelaten eyn harlich klenade als synen licham unde blot eyner geystlyken artzedye unde spyse, dar wy syner scholen by gedencken, dorch welkeren licham unde blot he uns eyn enych testamente der salicheyt hefft upgerichtet unde dat sulvyge testamente synes flesches unde blödes myt synem bytteren lydende bokrefftyget. Unde ßo vaken wy uns myt sunden folet besweret unde uns na dysser spise unde na dyssem drancke hungeret unde dorstet, schole wy yth myt eyneme gruntligen unde fasten geloven entfangen. Unde so vaken wy yth tho uns nemen, schole wy andechtich ßyn, synes bytteren lydendes eme danck und loff tho seggen vor syne woldath unde dat unß desse spyse mege syn helplich unde tröstlich thom ewygem levende. Amen. Spreket my na myt ynnygem harten: O Here Jesu Christi, du sone des levendygen Gades, de du uth vederlykem willen, dorch medewarkinge des hilgen gestes, dorch dynen bytteren doth de werlt heffst wedder levendich ghemaket dorch den geloven, erlöse uns armen kynder Ade dorch dyssen dynen hylgen licham unde unschuldigen bloth van allen unsen ungerechticheyden unde bosheyden unde vorlene uns, dat vy alle tydt gehorßam dynen gebaden myt lust unde leve volgen unde van dy nummer affgesundert werden. Amen. O Here, ick en byn nycht werdich dorch myn vordenst dynes werdigen lichames unde blödes, sunder make my werdich dorch dyne gotlike tosage, make my salich dorch dyn heylsame wort. Amen.

*Thereafter the priest turneth with the body of Christ to the people. And the communicants seat themselves all in a row before the altar to receive the sacrament. And the priest maketh an exhortation and saith, holding the body of Christ in his hand:* Good friends, Christ our Saviour hath left us at his last departing a glorious jewel, to wit his body and blood, for a spiritual medicine and food, whereby we shall remember him; through which body and blood he hath set up for us an only testament of salvation, and confirmed the same testament of his flesh and blood with his bitter passion. And as often as we feel ourselves burdened with sins, and hunger and thirst after this food and after this drink, we shall receive it with a thorough and firm faith. And as often as we take it unto us, we shall be mindful to give him thanks and praise for his bitter passion, for his benefit, and that this food may be helpful and comfortable unto us unto everlasting life. Amen. Say after me with inward heart: O Lord Jesu Christ, thou Son of the living God, who by the Father's will, through the working together of the Holy Ghost, hast by thy bitter death made the world alive again through faith: deliver us poor children of Adam, by this thy holy body and innocent blood, from all our iniquities and wickednesses, and grant us that we may at all times follow thy commandments obediently with desire and love, and never be separated from thee. Amen. O Lord, I am not worthy by my merit of thy worthy body and blood; but make me worthy by thy divine promise, make me whole by thy wholesome word. Amen.

**Note.**

- **The priest holds the host** during the exhortation. The exhortation takes the place of the Canon's remembrance.
- ***Fili Dei vivi*** is the Strasbourg and Döber German text (§7.5.1, §7.8.8), said after the priest by the communicants. Three phrases are added:
  - "dorch den geloven" (the world made alive "through faith");
  - "uns armen kynder Ade";
  - "myt lust unde leve".
- ***Domine, non sum dignus.*** The Roman text is *Domine, non sum dignus, ut intres sub tectum meum: sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur anima mea* (Mt 8:8). It was said by the priest, and by the people before communion. The Kiel text changes it:
  - It drops the centurion's roof.
  - It makes the worthiness a question of merit ("dorch myn vordenst").
  - It asks that Christ's "divine promise" make the communicant worthy.

- "make my salich dorch dyn heylsame wort" keeps *sed tantum dic verbo, et sanabitur*.

**7.11.4 Communion of the bread; the cup-word and communion of the cup; blessing**

> *Nu vordelet de prester den licham Christi den communicanten, unde dat cor hevet an dat ander versus alßo: Dat wy des nummer vorgeten, gaff etc. Unde singet ßo lange, dat de licham Christi vordelet is. Dar na swicht dat chor stille. Unde de prester hevet vordan an, dat bloth Christi tho consecrerende unde secht:* Des sulven gelyken, do men gegeten hade, nam he den kelk yn syne hylligen, werdigen hende unde ßede dy dank unde gesegende den unde gaff an synen jüngeren, seggende: Nemet hen unde drincket alle daruth. Dyt ys de kelk mynes blödes, des nygen unde ewygen testamentes, de vor jw unde vor vele vorgaten wert yn vorgewinghe der sunde. Szo vaken gy dith don, ßo dot dat yn myner gedechnisse. *Nu gifft de prester den communicanten dat bloth Christi, unde dat chor singet: Jesus Christus, unser, edder den lavesanck: Got, de sy gelavet unde gebenediet etc. Unde singet ßolange dat bloth Christi vordelet is. Darna ßo ker sick de prester wedder to dem wolke [sic] unde secht:* De Here sy myt jw. *Unde beslut de mysse myt ener collecten. Unde na der collecten secht de prester noch eyn mal:* De Here sy myt jw. *Dar na list he disse nagescreven segenynge aver dat volck unde secht, Numeri VI. capite:* De Here segene jw unde bohode jw. De Her erluchte syn anghesichte aver jw unde sy jw gnedich. De Here hewe syn angesichte uppe jw unde ghewe jw frede, dorch Cristum, unßen heren. *Dat Chor antwardet:* Amen. *Dar na synget men eynen psalm, dat men de misse dar mede besluth.*

*Now the priest distributeth the body of Christ to the communicants, and the choir beginneth the second verse thus: "Dass wir des nimmer vergessen, gab etc.", and singeth so long till the body of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the choir is silent. And the priest beginneth further to consecrate the blood of Christ, and saith:* In like manner, when they had eaten, he took the cup into his holy and worthy hands, and said thanks unto thee, and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, saying: Take and drink ye all thereout. This is the cup of my blood, of the new and everlasting testament, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins. As often as ye do this, do it in my remembrance. *Now the priest giveth the communicants the blood of Christ, and the choir singeth "Jesus Christus unser", or the song of praise "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet", etc., and singeth so long till the blood of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the priest turneth again to the people and saith:* The Lord be with you. *And concludeth the Mass with a collect. And after the collect the priest saith once more:* The Lord be with you. *Thereafter he readeth this blessing written hereafter over the people, and saith, Numbers the sixth chapter:* The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face shine upon you and be gracious unto you. The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace, through Christ our Lord. *The choir answereth:* Amen. *Thereafter a psalm is sung, wherewith the Mass is concluded.*

**Note.**

- **"dat bloth Christi tho consecrerende".** The rubric calls the cup-word a consecration.
- **The cup-word** is Müntzer's *Simili modo*, but "testamentes" (not "bundes"), and without *mysterium fidei*.
- **No Our Father, no *Pax*, no *Agnus Dei*.** The Our Father is said with the Creed and the Verba on weekdays without communicants, and at the communion of the sick.

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## 7.12 Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540

Church order of the Elector Joachim II, 1540. Sehling 3, Mark Brandenburg Nr. 3, pp. 67–71.

The order is conservative. The Latin chants stay. The offertory chant stays. The Preface and Sanctus are sung in Latin. The Verba are sung aloud in German. The prayers the priest said before communion (*Domine Iesu Christe qui dixisti*, *Fili Dei vivi*, *Perceptio*) and after it (*Corpus tuum*, *Quod ore sumpsimus*) are kept in Latin.

In the Canon's own place, under the Sanctus, the priest says four new German collects. For the Pfalz-Neuburg version of these, Sehling notes: "Diese Gebete sind an die Stelle der in der römischen Messe teils vor teils nach der Konsekration gesprochenen Fürbittgebete gesetzt".

The order's rationale (p. 67) is given before the Mass:

> Es sollen auch verba consecrationis nach der prefation offentlich gesungen oder gesprochen werden, wie denn solchs von alters in der kirchen auch ublich gewesen […]. Daraus abzunemen, mit was grunde solche wort den leien mögen verboten werden. Allein der ursach, das man sich vielleicht besorget, sie mochten mit der zeit aus dem gewar und innen

> werden, das inen das sacrament des kelchs sowol zustünde als den priestern und villeicht daneben erfaren die ungeschicklichkeit ires canons, darauf sie fast alle seligkeit gestelt und doch denselben heimlich gelesen [...].

The words of consecration shall also be sung or spoken openly after the Preface, as this also hath been customary in the Church of old [...]. Whence may be gathered with what ground such words may be forbidden to the laity: only for this cause, that it was perhaps feared they might in time become aware thereby, and find out, that the sacrament of the cup belonged to them as well as to the priests; and perhaps besides discover the unfitness of their Canon, whereon they have set well-nigh all salvation, and yet read the same secretly [...].

#### 7.12.1 Creed, offertory, Preface, Sanctus

> *Darauf sol der priester singen, credo in unum deum, das patrem, in thumen und stiften sol latinisch, aber in den pfarren deudsch: Wir gleuben all an einen gott gesungen werden; darauf sol der priester singen: Dominus vobiscum absque oremus; darauf sol der gesang, den man hievor pro offertorio gehalten hat, gesungen werden; darauf sol der priester die gewönliche prefation singen und folgend das latinisch sanctus alles in latin gesungen werden. Unter dem sanctus sol der priester folgende oration deudsch beten.*

*Thereupon the priest shall sing Credo in unum Deum; the Patrem shall be sung in cathedrals and collegiate churches in Latin, but in the parishes in German, "Wir glauben all an einen Gott". Thereupon the priest shall sing Dominus vobiscum without Oremus; thereupon the chant which heretofore was kept for the offertory shall be sung; thereupon the priest shall sing the customary Preface, and next the Latin Sanctus, all sung in Latin. Under the Sanctus the priest shall pray the following prayer in German.*

**Note.**

- **The offertory.** "*Dominus vobiscum absque oremus*" keeps the greeting before the offertory but drops the *Oremus* that led into the offertory prayers. The offertory chant itself survives ("der gesang, den man hievor pro offertorio gehalten hat"). No offertory prayers are said.
- **In villages.** On p. 71 the order adds that "in den kleinen flecken ... und auf den dörfern" the offertory "von der dominica oder festen" may be replaced by a German psalm after the sermon: "darauf sol folgen die latinische prefation, das sanctus, die communio und ferrer der beschlus".
- **The Preface.** "Die gewönliche prefation" is the Latin Preface of the day. It is not printed.

#### 7.12.2 The four collects under the Sanctus (in place of the Canon's intercessions)

> *Fur die oberigkeit.* Barmherziger himlischer vater, in welches hende aller menschen gewalt und obrigkeit stehet, von dir eingesetzt zur straf der ubeltheter und zum schutz der fromen, in welches hende auch stehen alle recht und gesetze aller lender, wir bitten dich, sei gnedig unserm herrn kaiser, allen königen und fürsten, sonderlich unserm landesfursten und herrn N. und dem rath und regenten dieser stadt und aller ordenlichen obrigkeit, damit sie das weltlich schwerd, das du inen befohlen hast, recht füren mügen; umschattige sie mit der kraft des allerhöchsten, erleucht und erhalt sie bei deinem göttlichen namen, lass sie dein göttlichs wort von herzen lieb haben und darüber fest halten und sie ja dasselbig nicht lassen verfolgen, gib inen, lieber herr, weisheit und einen verstand und ein fridsam regiment, auf das sie alle ire unterthanen in der warheit und gerechtigkeit, die dir gefellig ist, regiren und beschirmen, auch, mein lieber gott, friste inen ir leben lang, nach deinem willen und weil das gerichte dein ist und sie an deiner stad sitzen, gib inen gnad, also zu regiren, das dein heiliger name durch sie geheiligt und gepreiset werde, von nu an bis in ewigkeit, das helf inen der herr Jesu Christ, dein geliebter son, amen.
>
> *Ein ander.* O almechtiger gütiger gott und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, der du uns ernstlich befohlen hast, das wir dich bitten sollen um arbeiter in deiner ernten, das ist um rechtschaffne prediger deines worts. Wir bitten dein gründlose barmherzigkeit, du wollest uns rechtschaffne lerer und diener deines göttlichen worts zuschicken und denselben dein heilsams wort in das herz und in den mund geben, das sie deinen befelch treulich ausrichten und nichts predigen, das deinem heiligen wort entgegen sei, auf das wir durch dein himlisch ewigs wort ermanet, geleret, gespeist, getröst und gesterkt werden, thun, was dir gefellig und uns fruchtbarlich ist; gib herr deiner heiligen christlichen kirchen deinen geist und göttliche weisheit, das dein wort unter uns laufe und wachse und mit aller freidigkeit, wie sichs gebürt, gepredigt und dein heilige christliche gemein dadurch gebessert werde, auf das wir mit bestendigem glauben dir dienen und in erkentnis deines namens bis an das ende verharren, durch unsern herrn etc.

> *Ein ander.* Almechtiger gott und ewiger vater, ein könig der ehren und ein herr himels und der erden, durch welches geist alle dinge regiret, durch welches fursehung alle dinge geordnet werden, du bist ein gott des friedes, von dem allein einigkeit zu uns komt, wir bitten dich durch unsern herrn Jesum Christum, du wollest uns unser sunde vergeben und mit deinem göttlichen friden und einigkeit begnaden, damit wir in forcht und zittern deinem namen dienen und allezeit von uns gepreiset werdest, amen.
>
> Barmherziger gott und himlischer vater, des barmherzigkeit kein ende hat, der du langmütig, gnedig und von grosser güte und treu bist und vergibst alle missethat, ubertretung und sunde, wir haben leider gesundigt mit unsern vetern, wir haben mishandelt und sind gottlos gewesen und dich oftmals erzürnet, dir allein haben wir gesundigt und ubel fur dir gethan, aber herr, gedenke nicht an unsere vorige missethat, las bald dein barmherzigkeit uber uns gross sein, denn wir sind elend worden, hilf uns gott unsers heils um der ehre willen deines namens, erlöse uns und vergib uns unser sunde durch deinen son Jesum Christum, amen.

*For the magistrates.* Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Highest; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereto, and in no wise suffer it to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

*Another.* O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hast earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest, that is, for right and true preachers of thy word: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and into their mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christian Church thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end; through our Lord, etc.

*Another.* Almighty God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered; thou art a God of peace, from whom alone unity cometh unto us: we beseech thee through our Lord Jesus Christ that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling, and that thou mayest be praised of us evermore. Amen.

Merciful God and heavenly Father, whose mercy hath no end, who art longsuffering, gracious and of great goodness and faithfulness, and forgivest all iniquity, transgression and sin: we have, alas, sinned with our fathers, we have done amiss and dealt wickedly and oftentimes provoked thee to wrath; against thee only have we sinned and done evil in thy sight. But, Lord, remember not against us our former iniquities; let thy mercy speedily be great upon us, for we are brought very low. Help us, O God of our salvation, for the glory of thy name; deliver us and forgive us our sins, through thy Son Jesus Christ. Amen.

**Note.** The texts and translations are the same as in `general_prayers.db` (family L). Sehling traces the collects for the ministers and for peace to Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. The one for the magistrates is an expanded form of the Nürnberg collect. The penitential fourth, woven from Ps 106:6, Ps 51:4 and Ps 79:8–9, stands where the Canon's prayers for forgiveness stood (*Hanc igitur*'s *ab aeterna damnatione nos eripi*, the *Nobis quoque peccatoribus*).

### 7.12.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation

> *Darnach verba consecrationis deudsch singen und eleviren wie folgt:* Unser herr Jesus in der nacht, do er verraten ward, nam er das brot, danket seinem himlischen vater, gebenedeiet es und brachs und gabs seinen jungern und sprach: Nemet hin und esset, das ist mein leib, der fur euch dargeben wird, das thut zu meiner gedechtnis. *Hic modica inclinatione, leva illud reverenter in altum. Deinde calicem accipe cum ambabus manibus, et dic.* Desselben gleichen nam

> er auch den kelch nach dem abendmal, danket und benedeiet in und gab den seinen jüngern und sprach: Trinket alle daraus, das ist mein blut des neuen testamentes, das vor euch und vor vil vergossen wird zur vergebung der sunden, solchs thut, so oft irs trinket, zu meinem gedechtnis. *Leua calicem in altum. Nach der elevation sol man in Thumen und stiften einen latinischen gesang singen, als das responsorium tua est potencia etc., in den pfarren aber einen deudschen gesang. Es wolt uns gott gnedig sein oder sei lob und dank mit hohem preis.*

*Thereafter the words of consecration shall be sung in German, and the elevation made, as followeth:* Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, blessed it, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. *Here, with a slight inclination, lift it up reverently on high. Then take the cup with both hands, and say:* Likewise also he took the cup after the supper, gave thanks and blessed it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Drink ye all of it, this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me. *Lift the cup on high. After the elevation, in cathedrals and collegiate churches a Latin chant shall be sung, as the responsory Tua est potentia, etc.; but in the parishes a German song: "Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein", or "Sei Lob und Dank mit hohem Preis".*

**Note.**

- **The Verba.** They are the Pauline and Lutheran form. "Danket seinem himlischen vater" keeps an echo of *tibi gratias agens*. The print's *gebenedeietes* is divided here as "gebenedeiet es".
- **Rubrics.** The Latin rubrics are those of the missal: *elevat … reverenter*, *accipit calicem ambabus manibus*.
- **The chant.** The Latin responsory after the elevation takes the place of the *Benedictus* sung at the elevation.

The elevation in the order of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.11, and as a mark of the feast in Chapter 12, §12.10.6.

#### 7.12.4 Our Father and the Peace

> *Darauf sol, wie hernach folget, das pater noster deudsch gesungen werden.* Last uns beten, wie uns der herr Christus Jesus befohlen hat, das wir aus rechter zuversicht und vertrauen dorfen sagen: Vater unser, der du bist im himel, geheiliget werde dein name, zukome dein reich, dein wil geschehe als im himel auch auf erden, unser teglich brod gib uns heute und vergib uns unser schulde als wir vergeben unsern schuldigern und für uns nicht in versuchung, sondern erlös uns von dem ubel, denn dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herrlichkeit in ewigkeit. *Dicat omnis populus, amen. Vertens se ad populum cantat.* Der fried des herren sei mit euch allen. *Dicat omnis populus, amen.*

*Thereupon the Pater noster shall be sung in German, as followeth.* Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth; give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors; and lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. *Let all the people say, Amen. Turning himself to the people he singeth:* The peace of the Lord be with you all. *Let all the people say, Amen.*

**Note.** "Wie uns der herr Christus Jesus befohlen hat, das wir … dorfen sagen" recasts *Praeceptis salutaribus moniti … audemus dicere*.

There is no embolism. *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum* is kept, with the people answering *Amen* where the Roman response is *Et cum spiritu tuo*.

#### 7.12.5 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers before communion (Latin)

> Agnus dei qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis. Agnus dei qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis. Agnus dei qui tollis peccata mundi, donna [*sic*] nobis pacem. *Das agnus dei sol auch latinisch gesungen werden. Inclina te.* Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti apostolis tuis, pacem meam do vobis, pacem meam relinquo vobis, ne respicias peccata mea, sed fidem ecclesiae tuae, eamque secundum voluntatem tuam pacificare custodire adiuvare et regere digneris, qui cum deo, patre et spiritu sancto vivis et regnas deus per omnia saecula saeculorum, amen. *Inclinatus dicat.* Domine Iesu Christi, fili dei vivi, qui ex voluntate patris cooperante spiritu sancto per mortem propriam mundum vivificasti. Libera nos per hoc sacrosanctum corpus et sanguinem tuum ab omnibus iniquitatibus et universis malis nostris: Et fac nos tuis semper obedire mandatis, et a tua misericordia nunquam in perpetuum separari permittas. Qui vivis et regnas deus per omnia saecula saeculorum, amen. *ALIA ORATIO.* Sacramentum corporis tui domine Iesu Christe, quod nos indigni tui sumere

> cupimus, non nobis proveniat in iudicium et condemnationem, sed pro tua pietate prosit nobis ad tutamen mentis et corporis, et ad medelam percipiendam, qui vivis et regnas cum deo patre in unitate spiritussancti deus per omnia saecula saeculorum, amen.

O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us. O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, grant us peace. *The Agnus Dei shall also be sung in Latin. Bow thyself.* O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles, My peace I give unto you, my peace I leave with you: regard not my sins, but the faith of thy Church; and vouchsafe to pacify, keep, help and govern her according to thy will; who with God the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest God, world without end. Amen. *Bowing, let him say:* O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, the Holy Ghost working with thee, hast by thine own death given life to the world: deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood from all our iniquities and all our evils; and make us ever to obey thy commandments, and suffer us never to be separated from thy mercy for evermore. Who livest and reignest God, world without end. Amen. *Another prayer.* Let the sacrament of thy body, O Lord Jesus Christ, which we unworthy desire to receive, not turn to us unto judgement and condemnation; but of thy goodness let it profit us unto the defence of mind and body, and unto the obtaining of healing; who livest and reignest with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost, God, world without end. Amen.

**Note.** These are the three prayers the priest said before his communion. Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (note 20–21) reports that in 1540 two were said, the third being an alternative to the second.

1. ***Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti.***
   - The two halves of John 14:27 are inverted: "do … relinquo", where the Roman text has *Pacem relinquo vobis, pacem meam do vobis*.
   - The verbs "pacificare custodire adiuvare et regere" are those of the Canon's *Te igitur* (*pacificare, custodire, adunare et regere*), with *adiuvare* for *adunare*. The Tridentine text has only *pacificare et coadunare*.
2. ***Fili Dei vivi.***
   - The Roman singular (*libera me … meis … fac me … inhaerere … a te*) is made plural and congregational.
   - *Inhaerere* becomes *obedire*.
   - *A te numquam separari* becomes *a tua misericordia nunquam in perpetuum separari*.
   - This petition, "Libera nos per hoc sacrosanctum corpus et sanguinem tuum", is not the embolism *Libera nos, quaesumus*.
3. ***Perceptio corporis tui*** appears as *Sacramentum corporis tui*.
   - It is plural, and *praesumo* becomes *cupimus*.
   - *Tutamen* stands for *tutamentum*. The stray *tui* after *indigni* is as printed.

#### 7.12.6 The exhortation (Osiander, Nürnberg 1533)

> *Deinde vertens se ad populum legat hanc adhortationem.* Ir allerliebsten in gott, dieweil wir itzt das abendmal unsers herrn Jesu Christi wollen bedenken und halten, darin er uns sein fleisch zu einer speis und sein blut zu einem trank, den glauben damit zu sterken, gegeben hat, sollen wir billich mit grossem fleiss ein jeder sich selbs prüfen, wie der heilig Paulus uns vermanet: denn dis heilig sacrament ist zu einem sondern trost und sterk gegeben den armen betrübten gewissen die ire sunde bekennen, gottes zorn und den tod forchten und nach der gerechtigkeit hungerig und durstig sind. So wir uns aber selbs prüfen und ein jeder in sein eigen gewissen gehen, wie uns der heilig Paulus leret, werden wir gewislich nicht anders finden, denn allerlei greuliche sund und den tod, den wir mit der sunde verschuldet haben, und können doch uns selbs in keinem wege daraus helfen. Darum hat unser lieber herr Jesus Christus sich uber uns erbarmet und ist um unser sunde willen mensche worden, auf das er das gesetz und allen willen gottes fur uns zu gut erfüllet und den tod und alles, was wir mit unsern sunden verschuldet hetten, fur uns und zu unser ledigung auf sich neme und erlitte, und das wir je das festiglich glauben und durch den glauben frölich in seinem willen mochten leben, nam er nach dem abendmal das brod, sagt dank, brachs und sprach: Nemet hin und esset, das ist mein leib, der fur euch dargeben wird, das ist, das ich mensch bin worden und alles, das ich thue und leide, ist alles euer eigen, fur euch und euch zu gut geschehen; des zu einem gewissen anzeigen und zeugnis gib ich euch mein leib zur speise. Desgleichen nam er auch den kelch und sprach: Nemet hin und trinket aus diesem alle, das ist der kelch des neuen testaments in meinem blut, das fur euch und fur viel vergossen wird zu vergebung der sunde, so oft ir das thut, solt ir mein darbei dabei [*sic*] gedenken, das ist, dieweil ich mich eur angenomen und eur sunde auf mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs fur die sunde in tod opfern, mein blut vergiessen, gnad und vergebung der sunde erwerben und also ein neu testament aufrichten, darinnen die

> sunde vergeben und ewig nicht mehr sol gedacht werden, des zu einem gewissen anzeigen und zeugnis, gib ich euch mein blut zu trinken. Wer nu also von diesem brod isset und von diesem kelch trinket, auch diesen worten, so er von Christo höret und diesen zeichen, die er von Christo empfahet, festiglich glaubt, der bleibt in dem herrn Christo und Christus in im, und wird ewiglich leben; darbei sollen wir nu sein gedenken und seinen tod verkündigen, nemlich, das er fur unser sunde sei gestorben und zu unser rechtfertigung wider auferstanden und im darum danksagen, ein jeder sein creuz auf sich nemen und im nachfolgen und nach seinem gebot einander lieben, wie er uns geliebt hat; denn wir sind alle ein brod und ein leib, dieweil wir alle eins brods teilhaftig sind und aus einem kelch trinken.

*Then turning himself to the people let him read this exhortation.* Dearly beloved in God, forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we ought rightly every one with great diligence to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength unto the poor troubled consciences that confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else but all manner of horrible sin, and death, which we have deserved with sin; and yet we cannot in any wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, to the end that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; that is, that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer is all your own, done for you and for your good; for a sure token and witness whereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this, this is the cup of the new testament in my blood, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins; as oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby; that is, forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever; for a sure token and witness whereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth of Christ and these signs which he receiveth of Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor; every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, seeing we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

**Note.** This is Osiander's Nürnberg exhortation (§7.8.7) as revised for Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, 195). It comes after the Latin priest's prayers and immediately before the distribution. *Darbei dabei* is a doublet in the print.

### 7.12.7 Communion

> *Darauf sol angefangen werden das responsorium discubuit Jesus latinisch und ob der communicanten viel weren, das man damit nicht zureichen mocht, sol man dem volk deudsch anfahen zu singen, gott sei gelobet, oder Jesus Christus, unser heiland, welcher gesenge einer, ob auch gleich das discubuit zureichet, dennoch gleichwol nach der communion sol gesungen werden. Nunc communicantes accedunt et cum eis corpus dominicum porrigitur dicat sacerdos.* Nim hin und iss, das ist der leib Christi, der fur dich geben ist. *Ad calicem dicat diaconus.* Nim hin und trink, das ist das blut des neuen testaments, das fur deine sunde vergossen ist.

*Thereupon shall be begun the responsory Discubuit Jesus in Latin; and if the communicants were many, so that it might not suffice therewith, one shall begin to sing to the people in German "Gott sei gelobet" or "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland"; one of which songs, even though the Discubuit suffice, shall nevertheless be sung after the communion. Now the communicants approach, and when the Lord's body is reached to them, let the priest say:* Take and eat, this is the body of Christ, which is given for thee. *At the cup let the deacon say:* Take and drink, this is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins.

**Note.** The communion formula is Lutheran, not Roman. *Corpus Domini nostri … custodiat* is not used. The Latin responsory *Discubuit Jesus* (from the Maundy Thursday office) serves as the communion chant.

### 7.12.8 Thanksgiving and the two Latin ablution prayers

> *Deinde vertens se ad populum legat sequentem graciarum actionem.* Last uns bitten. O almechtiger ewiger gott, wir sagen deiner göttlichen mildigkeit lob und dank, das du uns mit deinem heilsamen fleisch und blut deines einigen sons Jesu

> Christi, unsers herrn, gespeiset und getrenket hast, und bitten dich demütiglich, du wollest durch deinen heiligen geist in uns wirken, wie wir dis heilig sacrament mit dem munde haben empfangen, das wir auch also dein göttlich gnad, vergebung der sunde, vereinigung mit Christo und ewigs leben, so darinnen angezeigt und zugesagt ist, mit festem glauben mögen begreifen und ewiglich behalten. Wir danken dir auch, allmechtiger gott, das du uns durch diese heilsame gabe des leibes und bluts Christi, deines sons, hast erquicket, und bitten dein barmherzigkeit, das du uns solchs gedeihen lassest zum starken glauben gegen dir und zu brünstiger lieb unter uns allen, durch unsern herrn Jesum Christum, deinen son, der mit dir in ewigkeit des heiligen geists lebt und herschet, warer gott imer und ewiglich, amen. *Deinde inclinet se et dicat.* Corpus tuum domine quod nos peccatores sumpsimus, et calix quem potauimus, adhaereat visceribus nostris, et praesta omnipotens deus, ut ibi nulla remaneat peccati macula, ubi tua pura et sancta introierunt sacramenta, per eundem Christum dominum nostrum. Quod ore sumpsimus domine pura mente capiamus, et fiat nobis remedium sempiternum, per Christum dominum nostrum.

*Then turning to the people let him read the following thanksgiving.* Let us pray. O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith apprehend and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein set forth and promised. We thank thee also, almighty God, that thou hast refreshed us through this wholesome gift of the body and blood of Christ thy Son; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let the same prosper in us unto strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy Son, who with thee in eternity [*read*: unity] of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and eternally. Amen. *Then let him bow and say:* May thy body, O Lord, which we sinners have received, and the cup which we have drunk, cleave unto our inward parts; and grant, O almighty God, that no stain of sin may remain there where thy pure and holy sacraments have entered; through the same Christ our Lord. What we have received with the mouth, O Lord, may we take with a pure mind, and may it be unto us an everlasting remedy; through Christ our Lord.

**Note.**

- **The German thanksgiving.** It comes from Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. "In ewigkeit des heiligen geists" is evidently a slip for "in einigkeit"; Pfalz-Neuburg reads *einigkeit*.
- **The two Latin prayers.** They are the priest's prayers at the ablutions.
  - *Corpus tuum* is in the plural, with the wording "ut ibi nulla remaneat peccati macula, ubi … pura et sancta introierunt sacramenta". The Tridentine text reads "ut in me non remaneat scelerum macula, quem pura et sancta refecerunt sacramenta".
  - *Quod ore sumpsimus* lacks *et de munere temporali*. Pfalz-Neuburg restores it.
- **The blessing.** Sehling notes that the 1540 and 1542 prints end here. The blessing printed in Mylius's edition is not in them.

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## 7.13 Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542

Church order of Duchess Elisabeth for the principality of Calenberg-Göttingen, drawn up by Antonius Corvinus, 1542. Sehling 6, III, pp. 813–817 (`eko.db` doc 2036), with the Masses for the church year on pp. 819–834 (doc 2037).

The Sacrament is taken from Brandenburg 1540 (§7.12), put into German throughout:

- the collect for the magistrates prayed by the priest under the Sanctus;
- the *Pax Domini*;
- the Brandenburg thanksgiving.

To these Göttingen adds a *custodiat* at the distribution, which Brandenburg lacks.

Brandenburg's Latin *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* becomes a German postcommunion collect. The proper Masses for the church year take many of their introits, collects, readings and Prefaces from Müntzer's German Mass (§7.4; Radical Reformation). Sehling's notes to doc 2037 say so at each place, e.g. p. 821 n. 84: "Vgl. dieselbe Präfation bei Müntzer, Deutsch ev. messe v. 1524". The route is given in Sehling's note 26 (p. 812): "Corvinus hat hier auf dem Wege über die Erfurter Kirchenämter z. T. die Altargesänge und liturgischen Texte Thomas Müntzers übernommen". The Erfurt *Kirchenamt* of 1525 added a Trinity Mass to Müntzer's five, and a second Erfurt print added the Ascension, the Sacrament and the Apostles.

### 7.13.1 Offertory, Preface, Sanctus, and the collect under the Sanctus

> *Darnach gehet der priester wider vor den altar und singet der chor in mitteler zeit: Es wolt uns Gott gnedig sein etc. ader Gott der Vater wone uns bey etc. Darnach singet der priester:* Der Herre sey mit euch! *Antwort der chor:* Und mit deinem geiste. *Darnach volget das offertorium. Anstat des offertorii sol man mit der gemein einen deutschen psalm singen.* Gott sey preis von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen. Der Herre sey mit euch, und mit deinem geiste. Hebet auf euer herzen! Die erheben wir zum Herren. Lasset uns danksagen dem Herren, unserm Gotte! Das ist billich und ist recht! Warlich ist das billich und recht und heilsam, das wir dir danken, heiliger Herr, almechtiger Vater, ewiger Gott, durch Christum, unsern Herren, der das ware osterlamb ist, der ist warlich das lamb, das der welt sünde tregt, der unsern todt mit seinem sterben verstöret hat und das leben mit seiner auferstehunge erworben hat. Darumb singen wir mit seinen engeln und erzengeln deiner ehr ein lobgesang, ohn end sprechende: *Das Sanctus.* Jesaia dem propheten das geschach, das er im geist den Herren sitzen sach auf einem hohen thron in hellem glanz, seines kleides saum den chor füllet ganz. […] Heilig ist Gott, der Herre Zebaoth! Heilig ist Gott, der Herre Zebaoth! Heilig ist Gott, der Herre Zebaoth! Sein ehr die ganze welt erfüllet hat. […] *Unter dem Sanctus bete der priester dieser oration oder collecten eine. Für die oberkeit.* Barmherziger himlischer Vater, in welches hende aller menschen gewalt und oberkeit stehen, von dir eingesetzt zur straffe der übeltheter und zum schutz der fromen, in welches hende auch stehen alle rechte und gesetze aller lender, wir bitten dich, sey gnedig unserm keiser, allen königen und fürsten, sonderlich unser landesfürstinnen und der jungen herschaft, rath und regenten dieser stad und aller ordentlicher obrigkeit, damit sie das weltliche schwerd, das du ihnen befolhen hast, recht füren mügen. Umbschetige sie mit der kraft des allerhöchsten, erleuchte und erhalt sie bey deinem göttlichen namen! Las sie dein göttlichs wort von herzen lieb haben und darüber vesthalten und sie ja dasselbige nicht lassen verfolgen. Gib ihn, lieber Herr, weisheit und einen verstand und ein friedsam regiment, auf das sie alle ihre underthan in der warheit und gerechtigkeit, die dir gefellig ist, regiren und beschirmen. Auch, mein lieber Gott, friste ihn ihr leben lang nach deinem willen. Und weil das gerichte dein ist und sie an deiner stat sitzen, gib ihn gnade, also zu regiren, das dein heiliger name durch sie geheiliget und gepreiset werde von nu an bis in ewigkeit. Das helf ihn der Herr Jhesu Christ, dein geliebter Sohn. Amen.

*Thereafter the priest goeth again before the altar, and the choir singeth in the meantime: "Es wollt uns Gott genädig sein", etc., or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei", etc. Thereafter the priest singeth:* The Lord be with you! *The choir answereth:* And with thy spirit. *Thereafter followeth the offertory. In the stead of the offertory a German psalm shall be sung with the congregation.* Praise be to God from everlasting to everlasting. Amen. The Lord be with you, and with thy spirit. Lift up your hearts! We lift them up unto the Lord. Let us give thanks unto the Lord our God! That is meet and is right! Verily this is meet and right and wholesome that we should give thanks unto thee, holy Lord, almighty Father, everlasting God, through Christ our Lord, who is the true Passover lamb; he is verily the Lamb that beareth the sin of the world, who hath destroyed our death by his dying, and hath won life by his rising again. Therefore we sing with his angels and archangels a song of praise to thine honour, saying without end: *The Sanctus.* Isaiah the prophet, it befell him that he in the spirit saw the Lord sitting upon a high throne in bright splendour; the hem of his garment filled all the choir. […] Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! Holy is God, the Lord of Sabaoth! His glory hath filled the whole world. […] *Under the Sanctus let the priest pray one of these prayers or collects. For the magistrates.* Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands stand the power and authority of all men, ordained by thee for the punishment of evil-doers and for the protection of the godly; in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our emperor, all kings and princes, specially unto our sovereign lady and the young lordship, the council and governors of this city and all orderly authority, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of the Most High, enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name! Let them love thy divine word from the heart and hold fast thereby, and never suffer the same to be persecuted. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may govern and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will. And because the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to govern that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them from henceforth for evermore. This help them the Lord Jesus Christ, thy beloved Son. Amen.

**Note.**

- **"Anstat des offertorii".** The offertory keeps its name and place ("Darnach volget das offertorium") as a German hymn.
- **"Gott sey preis von ewigkeit zu ewigkeit. Amen."** This is *Per omnia saecula saeculorum. Amen*, the end of the Secret, sung before the Preface dialogue. Müntzer has it in the same place as "durch alle ewigkeit der ewigkeit. Amen" (§7.4.1).
- **The Preface** is the Easter Preface. Sehling's note refers it to the Roman Easter Preface.
- **The Sanctus** is Luther's German Sanctus (*Deutsche Messe*).

- **The collect** is the first of Brandenburg's four collects under the Sanctus (§7.12.2), adapted to a duchess-regent ("unser landesfürstinnen und der jungen herschaft"). As there, it stands in the place of the Canon's intercessions. The Masses for the church year (doc 2037) repeat it or give other collects "so der priester unter dem Sanctus betet".

### 7.13.2 Our Father, Verba, communion with the *custodiat*, the Peace

> Last uns beten, wie uns der Herr Christus Jesus bevolen hat, das wir aus rechter zuversicht und vertrauen dorfen sagen: Vater unser, der du bist im himel, geheiliget werde dein nahme, zukom dein reich, dein will geschehe als im hymel und auf erden. Unser teglich brod gib uns heute, und vergib uns unser schulde, als wir vergeben unsern schüldigern! Und führ uns nicht in versuchung, sondern erlöse uns von dem übel; denn dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herligkeit in ewigkeit. Amen. *Verba consecrationis.* Unser Herr Jhesus in der nacht, da er verrhaten ward, nam er das brod, danket seinem himlischen Vater und brachs und gabs seinen jüngern und sprach: Nemet hin und esset, das ist mein leib, der fur euch dargegeben wird, das thut zu meinem gedechtnis. Desselbigengleichen nam er auch den kelch nach dem abentmal, danket und gab den seinen jüngern und sprach: Trinket alle daraus, das ist mein blut des neuen testamentes, das vor euch und vor vil vergossen wird zur vergebung der sünden, sölchs thut, so oft ihrs trinkt, zu meinem gedechtnis! *Hiemach sol der priester den leuhten das sacrament reichen und sagen:* Nim hin und iss, das ist der leib Christi, der vor dich gegeben ist, der behüte deine sele zum ewigen leben. Amen. Nim hin und trink, das ist das blut des neuen testaments, das vor deine sünde vergossen ist, das sterke deine sehle zum ewigen leben. Amen. *Und sing man indes das Discubuit odder Jhesus Christus, unser heiland etc. oder Gott sey gelobet. Wenn die letzten zugehen, so beschliesse der chor mit demselbigen versen. Darnach singe der priester:* Der friede des Herrn sey mit euch! *Der chor singt:* Und mit deinem geiste!

Let us pray, as the Lord Christ Jesus hath commanded us, that out of right confidence and trust we may be bold to say: Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name, thy kingdom come, thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors! And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil; for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen. *The words of consecration.* Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks unto his heavenly Father, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat, this is my body, which is given for you; this do in remembrance of me. After the same manner he took also the cup after the supper, gave thanks, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Drink ye all of it, this is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the forgiveness of sins; this do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! *Hereafter the priest shall give the sacrament to the people and say:* Take and eat, this is the body of Christ, which is given for thee; the same preserve thy soul unto everlasting life. Amen. Take and drink, this is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins; the same strengthen thy soul unto everlasting life. Amen. *And meanwhile let the Discubuit be sung, or "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", etc., or "Gott sei gelobet". When the last go up, let the choir close with the same verses. Thereafter let the priest sing:* The peace of the Lord be with you! *The choir singeth:* And with thy spirit!

**Note.**

- **The Our Father.** Brandenburg's recast *Praeceptis salutaribus* (§7.12.4) is kept.
- **The *custodiat*.** "der behüte deine sele zum ewigen leben" is the *custodiat*. "das sterke deine sehle" varies it for the cup. Brandenburg's own formula ("Nim hin und iss …") has no *custodiat*.
- **The *Pax Domini*** follows the communion, as a greeting of peace before the thanksgiving. The Roman response is kept.
- **The communion chant.** *Discubuit Iesus* is the responsory that Brandenburg also prescribes (§7.12.7).

### 7.13.3 Thanksgiving, *Agnus Dei*, and *Qui dixisti* as the final collect

> *Hirauf volgt die danksagung, so man in allen messen nach geschehener communion thun sol, und keret sich der priester zu dem volk und spricht:* O almechtiger, ewiger Gott, wir sagen deiner göttlicher mildigkeit lob und dank, das du uns mit deinem heilsamen fleisch und blut deines einigen Sons Jhesu Christi, unsers Herrn, gespeiset und getrenket hast, und bitten dich demütiglich, du wollest durch deinen heiligen Geist in uns wirken, wie wir diss heilige sacrament mit dem munde haben entpfangen, das wir auch also deine götliche gnaden, vergebunge der sünden, voreinigunge mit Christo und ewiges leben, so darinnen angezeigt und zugesagt ist, mit festem glauben mögen begreifen und ewiglich behalten. Wir danken dir auch, almechtiger Gott, das du uns durch die heilsame gabe deines leibes und bluts hast erquicket, und bitten dein barmherzigkeit, das du uns solchs gedeien lassest zu starkem glauben gegen dir und zu brünstiger liebe gegen uns allen durch unsern Herrn Jhesum Christum, deinen Sohn, der mit dir in ewigkeit des heiligen Geists lebt und

> herschet, warer Gott ymmer und ewiglich. Amen. Gehet hin im frieden! *Das Agnus Dei.* O lamb Gottes unschuldig, am stam des kreuzs geschlachtet, allezeit gefunden düldig, wiewol du werst verachtet, all sund hastu getragen, sonst müsten wir verzagen, erbarm dich unser, o Jhesu! *Hieauf volgt die collect, die singet der priester.* O Herr Jhesu Christe, der du deinen apostelen gesagt hast: Meinen friden geb ich euch, meinen friden lass ich euch!, wollest unser sünde nicht gedenken, sonder ansehen den glauben deiner gemein. Die wöllestu im friden erhalten, bewaren und regiren, der du mit dem Vater und dem heiligen Geiste, warer Gott, herschest und regirest in ewigkeit. Amen. *Hienach volget die benedictio:* Der Herre segne dich und behüte dich! Der Herre erleuchte sein angesicht über dir und sey dir gnedig! Der Herre hebe sein angesicht auf dich und gebe dir friede! *Singet der priester:* Lasset uns den Herren preisen, alleluja! *Der chor:* Danket dem Herren, alleluja! *Beschliesse mit dem Da pacem, Verley uns friden etc. mit der collecten.*

*Hereupon followeth the thanksgiving, which shall be made in all Masses after the communion is done; and the priest turneth to the people and saith:* O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty, that thou hast fed and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ, our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Ghost, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also lay hold on thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein shown and promised, with firm faith, and keep them for ever. We thank thee also, almighty God, that thou hast refreshed us through the wholesome gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let it prosper unto us to strong faith toward thee and to fervent love toward us all; through our Lord Jesus Christ, thy Son, who with thee in the eternity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth, true God, ever and everlastingly. Amen. Go in peace! *The Agnus Dei.* O Lamb of God, unspotted, slain upon the tree of the cross, found patient at all times, although thou wast despised; all sins hast thou borne, else must we have despaired; have mercy upon us, O Jesu! *Hereupon followeth the collect, which the priest singeth.* O Lord Jesu Christ, who hast said to thine apostles: My peace I give unto you, my peace I leave with you!, vouchsafe not to remember our sins, but look upon the faith of thy congregation; which vouchsafe thou to keep in peace, to preserve and to govern; who with the Father and the Holy Ghost, true God, rulest and reignest for ever. Amen. *Hereafter followeth the blessing:* The Lord bless thee and keep thee! The Lord make his face shine upon thee and be gracious unto thee! The Lord lift up his countenance upon thee and give thee peace! *The priest singeth:* Let us praise the Lord, alleluia! *The choir:* Give thanks unto the Lord, alleluia! *Let him conclude with the Da pacem, "Verleih uns Frieden", etc., with the collect.*

**Note.**

- **The thanksgiving** is Brandenburg's, made of two parts (§7.12.8). Brandenburg's Latin ablution prayers after it are dropped.
- **"Gehet hin im frieden!"** is *Ite, missa est* in German.
- **The *Agnus Dei*** is Decius' hymn, moved after the thanksgiving.
- **The final collect is *Domine Iesu Christe, qui dixisti* in German.** It is the priest's prayer for the peace of the Church, said in the Roman Mass before the kiss of peace and kept by Brandenburg in Latin before communion (§7.12.5). Sehling's note: "Die folgende Kollekte ist in der KO für die Mark Brandenburg von 1540 … in lat. Fassung enthalten. Vgl. dazu Röm. Meßbuch … (Ordo Missae, Friedensgebet)". Here it becomes a collect sung aloud to close the Mass.
  - The verbs "erhalten, bewaren und regiren" follow Brandenburg's *pacificare custodire … regere* (§7.12.5).
  - "den glauben deiner gemein" puts "congregation" for *ecclesiae tuae*.
- **The Easter *Benedicamus*.** "Lasset uns den Herren preisen, alleluja / Danket dem Herren, alleluja" is the Easter *Benedicamus Domino, alleluia / Deo gratias, alleluia*.

### 7.13.4 From the Masses for the church year

The proper Masses (doc 2037) end with proper collects in the same slot. For Whitsun it is Müntzer's closing prayer (Sehling: "Kollekte aus Müntzers Deutsch ev. messe v. 1524"), which is a German version of the Roman Whitsun postcommunion *Sancti Spiritus, Domine, corda nostra mundet infusio: et sui roris intima aspersione fecundet* (§7.4.4):

> O Herr, verleihe uns die gnad des heiligen Geists, auf das der tau deiner güte unsern grund des herzens in seiner besprengung fruchtbar mache […].

O Lord, grant us the grace of the Holy Ghost, that the dew of thy goodness may make the ground of our heart fruitful by its sprinkling […].

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## 7.14 Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543

Church order of Count Palatine Ottheinrich, 1543. Sehling 13, I.2, pp. 70–76 (Mass). Canon critique: pp. 64–65, Appendix 7.A.

Sehling notes that the Mass follows Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, with additions from Brandenburg 1540. Its shape differs from both in three ways:

1. **No Preface.** Osiander's exhortation is moved to *before* the consecration.
2. **A new prayer over the elements.** Before the Verba the priest says Osiander's newly written prayer over the hosts and cup. In it he "brings before thy divine majesty these thy gifts, bread and wine". It serves as both an offertory and an epiclesis.
3. **The Sanctus after the Verba.** The Sanctus follows the Verba, and the Brandenburg collects are said under it.

After the Our Father, the Brandenburg Latin prayers follow. There are two changes to them: *Fili Dei vivi* reads **"ecclesiam tuam vivificasti"**, and *Sacramentum corporis* adds **"et sanguinis"**.

### 7.14.1 Creed, sermon, and the exhortation before the Lord's Supper

> *Nach dem evangelio sol der priester das Credo und der chor das Patrem lateinisch singen oder, wo kein chor ist, mag es der priester selbs singen oder sprechen und das volk dieweil das teutsch gesang: Wir glauben all in einen Gott lassen singen.* [...] *Wo man nun unter der messe prediget, da soll der priester alsbald nach der predig wider uber den altar gehn und, damit das volk dester fleißiger und andechtiger alles, was hernach folget, vernehme, sol er oder einer aus den ministranten, wann man die hat, nachfolgende vermanung gegen dem volk lesen. Vermanung vor dem abendmal.* Ir allerliebsten in Got! Dieweil wir jetzo das heilig abendmal unsers Herrn Jesu Christi wöllen bedenken und halten, darin er uns sein fleisch zu einer speis und sein blut zu einem trank, den glauben darmit zu sterken, gegeben hat, sollen wir billich mit großem fleiß ein jeder sich selbs prüfen, wie uns der heilig Paulus vermanet; dann dis heilig sacrament ist zu einem sondern trost und sterk gegeben den armen, betrübten gewissen, die ire sünd empfinden und bekennen, Gottis zorn und den tod förchten und nach der gerechtigkeit hungerig und durstig sein. So wir aber uns selbs prüfen und ein jeder in sein eigen gewissen gehet, wie uns der heilig Paulus lehret, werden wir gewißlich nicht anders finden, dann allerlei greuliche sünd und den tod, den wir mit der sünd verschuldet haben, und können doch uns selbs in keinen weg daraus helfen. Darumb hat unser lieber Herr Jesus Christus sich uber uns erbarmet und ist umb unserer sünde willen mensch worden, auf das er das gesetz und allen willen Gottis fur uns und uns zu gut erfüllet und den tod und alles, was wir mit unsern sünden verschuldet hetten, fur uns und zu unserer erledigung auf sich neme und erlitte. Und auf das wir das je festiglich glauben und durch den glauben frölich in seinem willen möchten leben, nam er nach dem abendmal das brot, sagte dank, brachs und sprach: Nembt hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch dargegeben wirt, das ist: Das ich mensch bin worden und alles, das ich tue und leide, ist alles euer eigen, für euch und euch zu gut geschehen. Des zu einem gewissen anzeigen und zeugnus gib ich euch mein leib zur speise. Desselben gleichen nam er auch den kelch und sprach: Nempt hin und trinket aus disem alle! Das ist der kelch des neuen testaments in meinem blut. So oft ir das tut, solt ir mein darbei gedenken. Das ist: Dieweil ich mich euer angenomen und euer sünd auf mich geladen hab, will ich mich selbs für die sünd in tod opfern, mein blut vergießen, genad und vergebung der sünd erwerben und also ein neu testament aufrichten, darin die sünd vergeben und ewig nicht mer soll gedacht werden. Des zu einem gewissen anzeigen und zeugnus gib ich euch mein blut zu trinken. Wer nun also von disem brot isset und von disem kelch trinkt, auch disen worten, die er von Christo höret, und disen zeichen, die er von Christo empfahet, festiglich glaubet, der bleibt in dem Herrn Christo und Christus in im und wirt ewiglich leben. Darbei sollen wir nun sein gedenken und seinen tod verkündigen, nemlich, das er für unser sünd sei gestorben und zu unserer rechtfertigung wider auferstanden, und ihm darumb danken, ein jeder sein creuz auf sich nemen und im nachvolgen und nach seinem gebot einander lieben, wie er uns geliebt hat; dann wir sein alle ein brot und ein leib, dieweil wir alle eins brots teilhaftig sein und aus einem kelch trinken.

*After the Gospel the priest shall sing the Credo and the choir the Patrem in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may himself sing or say it, and meanwhile let the people sing the German song "Wir glauben all an einen Gott".* [...] *Where now one preacheth during the Mass, the priest shall forthwith after the sermon go again to the altar; and, that the people may the more diligently and devoutly perceive all that followeth, he, or one of the ministers if there be any, shall read the following exhortation toward the people. Exhortation before the Supper.* Dearly beloved in God! Forasmuch as we will now consider and keep the holy supper of our Lord Jesus Christ, wherein he hath given us his flesh for a meat and his blood for a drink, therewith to strengthen faith, we

ought rightly every one with great diligence to examine himself, as the holy Paul exhorteth us; for this holy sacrament is given for a special comfort and strength unto the poor, troubled consciences which feel and confess their sins, fear God's wrath and death, and are hungry and thirsty after righteousness. But when we examine ourselves, and every one goeth into his own conscience, as the holy Paul teacheth us, we shall surely find nothing else but all manner of horrible sin, and death, which we have deserved with sin; and yet we cannot in any wise help ourselves out thereof. Therefore hath our dear Lord Jesus Christ had mercy upon us, and for our sins' sake is become man, to the end that he might fulfil the law and all the will of God for us and for our good, and take upon himself and suffer death and all that we had deserved with our sins, for us and for our deliverance. And to the end that we might steadfastly believe this, and through faith live joyfully in his will, he took after the supper the bread, gave thanks, brake it, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you; that is: that I am become man, and all that I do and suffer is all your own, done for you and for your good. For a sure token and witness whereof I give you my body for meat. Likewise he took also the cup, and said: Take and drink ye all of this! This is the cup of the new testament in my blood. As oft as ye do this, ye shall remember me thereby. That is: forasmuch as I have taken your cause upon me and laden your sins upon myself, I will offer myself unto death for sin, shed my blood, obtain grace and forgiveness of sins, and so set up a new testament, wherein sins are forgiven and shall be remembered no more for ever. For a sure token and witness whereof I give you my blood to drink. Whosoever now eateth thus of this bread and drinketh of this cup, and firmly believeth these words which he heareth of Christ and these signs which he receiveth of Christ, he dwelleth in the Lord Christ and Christ in him, and shall live for ever. Hereby shall we now remember him and show forth his death, namely that he died for our sins and rose again for our justification, and give him thanks therefor; every one take up his cross and follow him, and according to his commandment love one another, as he hath loved us: for we are all one bread and one body, seeing we are all partakers of one bread and drink of one cup.

**Note.** This is the Brandenburg text (§7.12.6), which Sehling traces from 1540 back to 1533. It is moved from before the distribution to before the consecration. There are two changes:

- **The cup word** stops at "in meinem blut". It lacks "das fur euch und fur viel vergossen wird zu vergebung der sunde".
- **The consciences** "feel and confess" their sins ("empfinden und bekennen").

#### 7.14.2 Osiander's prayer over the hosts and cup (offertory and epiclesis)

> *Nach diser vermanung sol der priester uber die hostien und den kelch, die nach anzal und gelegenheit der personen, so zum heiligen sacrament gehn wöllen, auf den altar verordnet sein sollen, dises nachfolgendes gebet sprechen: Gebet.* Herr Jesu Christe, du einiger warer son des lebendigen Gottis, der du dein leib fur uns alle in den bittern tod hast dargeben und dein bluot zu vergebung unserer sünd vergossen, darzu denselben dein leib und dasselbig dein bluot allen deinen jungern zu essen und zu trinken und deines tods darbei zu gedenken hast befolhen. Wir bringen fur deine götliche majestat dise deine gaben, brot und wein, und bitten, du wöllest dieselben durch dein götliche gnad, gute und kraft heiligen, segnen und schaffen, das dises brot dein leib und diser wein dein blut sei, und allen denen, die darvon essen und trinken, zum ewigen leben lassen gedeihen, der du mit Got dem Vater in einigkeit des Heiligen Geists lebst und regirest immer und ewiglich. Amen.

*After this exhortation the priest shall say this following prayer over the hosts and the cup, which shall be set upon the altar according to the number and occasion of the persons that will go to the holy sacrament: Prayer.* Lord Jesus Christ, thou only true Son of the living God, who hast given thy body for us all into the bitter death, and shed thy blood for the forgiveness of our sins, and hast moreover commanded all thy disciples to eat the same thy body and to drink the same thy blood, and therewith to remember thy death: we bring before thy divine majesty these thy gifts, bread and wine, and beseech thee that thou wouldest, by thy divine grace, goodness and power, hallow and bless the same, and make that this bread be thy body and this wine thy blood, and let them prosper unto everlasting life unto all them that eat and drink thereof; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and eternally. Amen.

**Note.** Sehling calls this an offertory prayer newly written by Osiander, and cites Graff's study of the epiclesis in Reformation orders. Addressed to Christ, not to the Father, it gathers four parts of the Canon into one prayer said over the elements:

| Osiander 1543 | Roman source |
|---|---|
| "Herr Jesu Christe, du einiger warer son des lebendigen Gottis" | *Domine Iesu Christe, Fili Dei vivi* |

| Osiander 1543 | Roman source |
|---|---|
| "Wir bringen fur deine götliche majestat dise deine gaben, brot und wein" | *Unde et memores*: *offerimus praeclarae maiestati tuae de tuis donis ac datis*; also *Te igitur*: *haec dona, haec munera* |
| "du wöllest dieselben … heiligen, segnen und schaffen, das dises brot dein leib und diser wein dein blut sei" | *Quam oblationem*: *benedictam … facere digneris, ut nobis Corpus et Sanguis fiat* |
| "allen denen, die darvon essen und trinken, zum ewigen leben lassen gedeihen" | *Supplices*: *ut quotquot ex hac altaris participatione … sumpserimus, omni benedictione caelesti et gratia repleamur* |

It meets the demand of the critique printed earlier in the same order (Appendix 7.A) only half-way. The verb there objected to, *opfern*, becomes *bringen … fur deine götliche majestat*, and the gifts are "thy gifts, bread and wine", not the body and blood.

### 7.14.3 The Verba, sung, with elevation

> *Alsobald nach disem gebet sol er anfahen, die verba consecrationis zu singen oder mit lauter, wolvernemlicher stimme zu sprechen, wie er andre gesang vormals gesungen oder gesprochen hat, wie hernach folget, und sol sich fleißigen, das seine geberd mit den worten sich vergleichen, das ist: Wann er singt: Nam er das brot…, so sol er auch die großen hostien nemen und seiner brust gleich halten, bis die wort volendet sein. Desgleichen, wenn er singt: Nam er den kelch…, sol er mit dem kelch auch also tun, wie vorgemelt ist.* Unser Herr Jesus in der nacht, da er verraten ward, nam er das brot, danket und brachs und gabs seinen jungern und sprach: Nembt hin und esset! Das ist mein leib, der für euch gegeben wirt. Das tut zu meinem gedechtnus! *Hie sol er die großen hostia mit geneigtem haupt aufheben und dem volk zaigen, darnach auch den kelch nemen und halten, bis er die volgenden wort singt oder spricht:* Desselben gleichen nam er auch den kelch nach dem abendmal und danket und gab in den und sprach: Trinkt alle daraus! Das ist mein blut des neuen testamentes, das für euch und fur vil vergossen wird zu vergebung der sünden. Solchs tut, so oft irs trinkt, zu meinem gedechtnus! *Hie sol er den kelch auch aufheben und dem volk zaigen.*

*As soon as this prayer is ended he shall begin to sing the words of consecration, or to say them with a loud, well-audible voice, as he hath aforetime sung or said other chants, as hereafter followeth; and he shall take care that his gestures agree with the words; that is, when he singeth "He took the bread …", he shall also take the large host and hold it level with his breast until the words be ended. Likewise, when he singeth "He took the cup …", he shall do so with the cup also, as aforesaid.* Our Lord Jesus, in the night in which he was betrayed, took the bread, gave thanks, and brake it, and gave it to his disciples, and said: Take and eat! This is my body, which is given for you. This do in remembrance of me! *Here he shall lift up the large host with bowed head and show it to the people; thereafter take also the cup and hold it, until he sing or say the following words:* Likewise also he took the cup after the supper, and gave thanks, and gave it to them, and said: Drink ye all of it! This is my blood of the new testament, which is shed for you and for many for the remission of sins. This do, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me! *Here he shall lift up the cup also and show it to the people.*

**Note.** The Verba are sung to the Our Father tone, following Luther's suggestion in the *Formula missae* and the Nürnberg melody of 1533. The large host is kept, a relic of the Roman fraction host. The elevation is kept, with a bowed head.

### 7.14.4 Sanctus with three collects

> *Darnach sol der chor das Sanctus lateinisch singen oder, wo kein chor ist, mag es der priester selbs singen oder sprechen und anstatt desselben das volk darfur ein gut teutsch geistlich lied lassen singen, und unter demselben gesang sol er dieweil dise nachfolgende gebet sprechen. Folgen die gebet, so der priester unter oder nach dem Sanctus sprechen sol. Fur die weltlichen obrigkeit.* Barmherziger, himlischer Vater, in welches hende aller menschlicher gewalt und obrigkeit stehet, von dir eingesetzt zur straf der ubelteter und zum schutz der frommen, in welches hende auch stehn alle recht und gesetz aller lender! Wir bitten dich, sei gnedig unserm herrn keiser, allen königen und fürsten, sonderlich unserm landsfürsten und herrn N. und dem rat und regenten diser statt und aller ordenlichen obrigkeit, damit sie das weltliche schwert, das du inen befolhen hast, recht füren mögen. Umbschatte sie mit der kraft deiner götlichen majestat! Erleucht und erhalt sie bei deinem götlichen namen! Laß sie dein göttlich wort von herzen lieb haben und sich demselbigen unterwerfen! Gib inen, lieber Herr, weisheit und verstand und ein fridsam regiment, auf das sie alle ire untertonen in der warheit und gerechtigkeit, die dir gefällig ist, regirn und beschirmen! Friste in auch, mein lieber Got, ir leben lang nach deinem willen

> und, dieweil das gericht dein ist und sie an deiner statt sitzen, so gib in gnad, also zu regirn, das dein heiliger name durch sie geheiliget und gepreiset werde von nun an bis in ewigkeit! Amen.
>
> *Fur die diener des worts.* O allmechtiger, gütiger Gott und Vater unsers Herren Jesu Christi, der uns ernstlich befolhen hat, das wir dich umb arbeiter in dein ernt bitten sollen! Wir bitten dein grundlose barmherzigkeit, du wöllest uns rechtgeschaffene lerer und diener deines götlichen worts zuschicken und denselben dein heilsames wort in ir herz und mund geben, das sie deinen befelch treulich ausrichten und nichts predigen, das deinem heiligen wort entgegen sei, auf das wir durch dein himelisch, ewig wort ermanet, gelert, gespeist, getröst und gesterkt werden und tun, was dir gefellig und uns fruchtbarlich ist. Gib, Herr, deiner heiligen christenheit deinen Geist und götliche weisheit, das dein wort unter uns lauf und wachs und mit aller freidigkeit, wie sichs gebürt, gepredigt und dein heilige, christliche gemein dardurch gebessert werd, auf das wir mit bestendigem glauben dir dienen und in erkanntnus deines namens bis ans ende verharren.
>
> *Umb christliche einigkeit.* Barmherziger Got und ewiger Vater, ein könig der ehren und ein herr himels und und der erden, durch welches Geist alle ding regirt, durch welches fürsehung alle ding geordnet werden! Du bist ein Got des frides, von dem alle einigkeit zu uns kompt. Wir bitten dich, du wöllest uns unser sünd vergeben und mit deinem götlichen frid und einigkeit begnaden, damit wir in forcht und zittern deinem namen immer und ewiglich dienen und dein götliche majestat allzeit von uns gepreist werde, durch unsern Herrn Jesum Christum, deinen son, der mit dir in einigkeit des Heiligen Geists lebt und regirt immer und ewiglich. Amen.

*Thereafter the choir shall sing the Sanctus in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may himself sing or say it, and in place thereof let the people sing a good German spiritual song; and under the same singing he shall meanwhile say these following prayers. There follow the prayers which the priest shall say under or after the Sanctus. For the temporal magistrates.* Merciful heavenly Father, in whose hands standeth all power and authority of men, ordained of thee for the punishment of evildoers and the protection of the godly, in whose hands also stand all the rights and laws of all lands: we beseech thee, be gracious unto our lord the Emperor, all kings and princes, especially unto our prince and lord of the land N., and unto the council and rulers of this city and all lawful magistrates, that they may rightly bear the temporal sword which thou hast committed unto them. Overshadow them with the power of thy divine Majesty; enlighten them and keep them in thy divine name; let them love thy divine word from the heart and submit themselves thereto. Give them, dear Lord, wisdom and understanding and a peaceable government, that they may rule and defend all their subjects in the truth and righteousness that is well-pleasing unto thee. Also, my dear God, prolong their life according to thy will; and forasmuch as the judgement is thine and they sit in thy stead, give them grace so to rule that thy holy name may be hallowed and praised through them, from henceforth even for ever. Amen.

*For the ministers of the word.* O almighty, gracious God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath earnestly commanded us that we should pray thee for labourers into thine harvest: we beseech thy bottomless mercy that thou wouldest send us right and true teachers and ministers of thy divine word, and give thy wholesome word into their heart and mouth, that they may faithfully perform thy commandment and preach nothing that is contrary to thy holy word; to the end that we, being by thy heavenly, eternal word admonished, taught, fed, comforted and strengthened, may do that which is well-pleasing unto thee and profitable unto us. Give, O Lord, unto thy holy Christendom thy Spirit and divine wisdom, that thy word may run and grow among us and be preached with all boldness, as it becometh, and that thy holy Christian congregation may be bettered thereby; that we may serve thee with steadfast faith and continue in the knowledge of thy name unto the end.

*For Christian unity.* Merciful God and everlasting Father, a King of glory and a Lord of heaven and of earth, by whose Spirit all things are governed, by whose providence all things are ordered: thou art a God of peace, from whom all unity cometh unto us. We beseech thee that thou wouldest forgive us our sins and endue us with thy divine peace and unity, that we may serve thy name in fear and trembling for ever and ever, and thy divine Majesty be praised of us evermore; through our Lord Jesus Christ thy Son, who with thee in the unity of the Holy Ghost liveth and reigneth ever and eternally. Amen.

**Note.** These are Brandenburg's first three collects (§7.12.2), with two changes to the collect for the magistrates:

- **"Umbschatte sie mit der kraft deiner götlichen majestat"** replaces "mit der kraft des allerhöchsten". It removes the Marian echo of Luke 1:35.
- **"Sich demselbigen unterwerfen"** replaces "darüber fest halten und sie ja dasselbig nicht lassen verfolgen". The magistrates are to *submit* to the Word, not merely protect it.

Brandenburg's fourth, penitential collect is dropped. Sehling's note on this passage explains the placing: "Diese Gebete sind an die Stelle der in der römischen Messe teils vor teils nach der Konsekration gesprochenen Fürbittgebete gesetzt. Sie wurden sonst in evangelischen Kirchenordnungen ohne Ersatz gestrichen, weil sie den von der Reformation abgelehnten Opfercharakter der Messe zur Grundlage haben." In other words, elsewhere the Canon's intercessions were cut without replacement, because they rest on the sacrificial character of the Mass.

#### 7.14.5 Our Father and the Peace

> *Wann dann das Sanctus oder andrer gesang geendet und dise gebet gesprochen sein, so sol er das Vater unser singen oder mit lauter stimme sprechen, wie hernach folget:* Last uns beten! Vater unser, der du bist im himel, geheiligt werd dein name! Zukom dein reich! Dein will geschehe als im himel auch auf erden! Unser teglich brot gib uns heut! Und vergib uns unser schulde, als wir vergeben unseren schuldigern! Und für uns nicht in versuchung, sonder erlös uns vom ubel! Dann dein ist das reich und die kraft und die herlichkeit in ewigkeit. *Chorus:* Amen. *Darnach wende er sich zum volk.* Der frid des Herren sei mit euch allen! *Chorus:* Amen.

*When then the Sanctus or other singing is ended and these prayers are said, he shall sing the Our Father or say it with a loud voice, as hereafter followeth:* Let us pray! Our Father, which art in heaven, hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done, as in heaven, so in earth. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: for thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. *Choir:* Amen. *Thereafter let him turn to the people.* The peace of the Lord be with you all! *Choir:* Amen.

**Note.** Of *Praeceptis salutaribus* only *Oremus* is left. There is no embolism.

#### 7.14.6 *Agnus Dei* and the priest's three prayers (Latin)

> *Darnach sol der chor oder, wo kein chor ist, der priester selbs das Agnus Dei, wie der brauch ist, singen oder aber sprechen und die weil das volk abermals ein gut teutsch geistlich gesang lassen singen, und unter demselbigen sol der priester auch dise nachvolgende gebet sprechen.* Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis! Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, miserere nobis! Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi, dona nobis pacem! Domine Jesu Christe, qui dixisti apostolis tuis: Pacem meam do vobis, pacem relinquo vobis, ne respicias peccata mea, sed fidem ecclesiae tuae, eamque secundum voluntatem tuam pacificare, custodire, adjuvare et regere digneris, qui cum Deo Patre et Spiritu Sancto vivis ac regnas, Deus per omnia secula seculorum! Amen. *Alia oratio:* Domine Jesu Christe, fili Dei vivi, qui ex voluntate Patris cooperante Spiritu Sancto ecclesiam tuam vivificasti. Libera nos per hoc sacrosanctum corpus et sanguinem tuum ab omnibus iniquitatibus et universis malis nostris et fac, nos semper obedire mandatis, et a tua misericordia nunquam in perpetuum separari permittas, qui vivis ac regnas, Deus per omnia secula seculorum! Amen. *Alia oratio:* Sacramentum corporis et sanguinis tui, Domine Jesu Christe, quod nos indigni sumere cupimus, non nobis proveniat in judicium et condemnationem, sed pro tua pietate prosit nobis ad tutamen mentis et corporis et ad medelam percipiendam, qui vivis et regnas cum Deo Patre in unitate Spiritus Sancti, Deus per omnia secula seculorum! Amen.

*Thereafter the choir, or, where there is no choir, the priest himself shall sing or else say the Agnus Dei, as the custom is, and meanwhile let the people again sing a good German spiritual song; and under the same the priest shall also say these following prayers.* O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us! O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, have mercy upon us! O Lamb of God, that takest away the sins of the world, grant us peace! O Lord Jesus Christ, who saidst unto thine apostles, My peace I give unto you, peace I leave with you: regard not my sins, but the faith of thy Church; and vouchsafe to pacify, keep, help and govern her according to thy will; who with God the Father and the Holy Ghost livest and reignest, God, world without end! Amen. *Another prayer:* O Lord Jesus Christ, Son of the living God, who by the will of the Father, the Holy Ghost working with thee, hast given life to thy Church: deliver us by this thy most holy body and blood from all iniquities and all our evils, and make us ever to obey thy commandments, and suffer us never to be separated from thy mercy for evermore; who livest and reignest, God, world without end! Amen. *Another prayer:* Let the sacrament of thy body and blood, O Lord Jesus Christ, which we unworthy desire to receive, not turn to us unto judgement and condemnation; but of thy goodness let it profit us unto the defence of mind and body, and unto the obtaining of healing; who livest and reignest with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost, God, world without end! Amen.

**Note.** These are the Brandenburg prayers (§7.12.5), with three changes:

1. ***Fili Dei vivi.*** "Per mortem propriam mundum vivificasti" becomes **"ecclesiam tuam vivificasti"**. The phrase about Christ's own death goes, and *the world* becomes *thy Church*.
2. ***Perceptio.*** "Corporis *et sanguinis* tui" adds the cup, which fits communion in both kinds.
3. **The rubric.** All three may be said, each marked *Alia oratio*.

#### 7.14.7 Communion

> *Darnach sollen zum sacrament gehn alle, die sich vor angesagt und die absolution empfangen haben, und der priester sol inen den leib des Herrn reichen mit disen worten:* Nimm hin und iß! Das ist der leib Christi, der für dich gegeben ist. *Desgleichen, wo man ministranten hat, sol der diaconus den kelch reichen denen, so den leib Christi genossen haben, und also sprechen:* Nimm hin und trink! Das ist das blut des neuen testaments, das für dein sünd vergossen ist. *Wo man aber nit ministranten hat, da sol der priester den leib des Herrn erstlich jederman reichen und darnach erst den kelch und, dieweil das geschicht, sol der chor das commun lateinisch singen und, wann es zu kurz were, ander gut lateinisch gesang mer, sonderlich, was de coena Domini ist, als das responsorium Discubuit Jesus. Wo aber kein chor ist, sol man die gemein abermals ein gut teutsch geistlich gesang, als da ist: Jesus Christus unser Heiland..., oder aber: Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet... oder ein andern gesang, der sich nach gelegenheit der zeit schicket, lassen singen. Wann nun jederman das heilig sacrament hat empfangen, so sol es dann der priester auch empfangen. Und, wiewol er von anfang sol fleiß haben, das er alle ding dermaßen verordne und in acht habe, damit von dem heiligen sacrament nit uberbleib, so sol er doch insonderheit zu ende darauf sehen, das es alles ausgeteilt werde und aufgehe, wie Christus befohlen hat, da er spricht Luce 22: Dividite inter nos..., auf das sich kein beschwerliche oder ergerliche unschicklicheit zutrag.*

*Thereafter all shall go to the sacrament who have announced themselves beforehand and have received the absolution; and the priest shall reach them the body of the Lord with these words:* Take and eat! This is the body of Christ, which is given for thee. *Likewise, where there are ministers, the deacon shall reach the cup to them that have partaken of the body of Christ, and say thus:* Take and drink! This is the blood of the new testament, which is shed for thy sins. *But where there are no ministers, the priest shall first reach the body of the Lord to every one, and only thereafter the cup; and while this is done, the choir shall sing the communion in Latin, and if it were too short, other good Latin chant more, especially what is de coena Domini, as the responsory Discubuit Jesus. But where there is no choir, the congregation shall again be let sing a good German spiritual song, such as "Jesus Christus unser Heiland …", or else "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet …", or another song that befitteth the occasion of the time. When now every one hath received the holy sacrament, then shall the priest also receive it. And although he shall from the beginning take diligent care so to order and heed all things that nothing of the holy sacrament remain over, yet he shall especially at the end see to it that it be all distributed and used up, as Christ hath commanded, where he saith, Luke 22: Dividite inter nos …, that no grievous or offensive unseemliness befall.*

**Note.**

- **The communion chant.** The Latin *communio* of the day survives as the communion chant.
- **The priest's communion.** It is moved after the people's, so that nothing is left over. Sehling gives the background: this began in Nürnberg in 1524, and Luther wished it in order to cut short the question of what becomes of Christ's body and blood in the remaining elements.
- **The quotation.** "Dividite inter nos" is as printed; the Vulgate reads *inter vos*.

#### 7.14.8 Thanksgiving, Latin ablution prayers, *Benedicamus*, blessing

> *Darnach soll er dise zwo collecten unter einem beschluß in gewonlichem ton singen oder mit vernemlicher stimme sprechen.* Laßt uns beten: O almechtiger, ewiger Gott. Wir sagen deiner götlichen miltigkeit lob und dank, das du uns mit dem heilsamen fleisch und blut deines einigen Sons Jesu Christi, unsers Herrn, gespeiset und getrenket hast, und bitten dich demütiglich, du wollest durch deinen Heiligen Geist in uns würken, wie wir dis heilige sacrament mit dem mund haben empfangen, das wir auch also dein göttlich gnad, vergebung der sünde, vereinigung mit Christo und ewigs leben, so darinnen angezeigt und zugesagt ist, mit festem glauben mögen begreifen und ewiglich behalten. *Ein ander gebet.* Wir danken dir auch, Herr Jesu Christe, das du uns durch dise heilsame gabe deines leibs und bluts hast erquicket, und bitten deine barmherzigkeit, das du uns solchs gedeihen lassest zu einem starken glauben gegen dir und zu brünstiger lieb unter uns allen, der du mit Got dem Vater in einigkeit des Heiligen Geists lebest und regirest immer und ewiglich. *Chorus:* Amen. *Deinde inclinet se et dicat:* Corpus tuum, Domine, quod nos peccatores sumpsimus, et calix, quem potavimus, adhaereat visceribus nostris, et praesta, ut ibi nulla remaneat peccati macula, ubi tam pura et sancta

> introierunt sacramenta. Quod ore sumpsimus, Domine, pura mente capiamus, et de munere temporali fiat nobis remedium sempiternum, per Christum, Dominum nostrum. Amen. *Darnach soll er oder seine diaconi bede oder einer unter dem ton, darunter man das Kyrieleison gesungen hat, das Benedicamus Domino singen, und der chor sol eben unter demselben ton antworten:* Deo dicamus gratias. *Darnach segne der priester das volk mit lauter vernemlicher stimm also:* Der Herr gesegen euch und behüte euch! Der Herr erleucht sein angesicht uber euch und sei euch gnedig! Der Herr erhebe sein angesicht auf euch und gebe euch frid! Amen. *oder also:* Got sei uns gnedig und barmherzig und gebe uns seinen göttlichen segen! Er laß uns sein angesicht leuchten und geb uns seinen frid! Amen. *oder also:* Gesegne und behüte uns Gott der Vater und der Sun und der Heilig Geist, Amen. *oder also:* Der Segen Gott des Vaters und des Suns und des Heiligen Geists sei mit euch und bleib allezeit bei uns allen! Amen. *Ende der meß mit communicanten.*

*Thereafter he shall sing these two collects under one conclusion in the accustomed tone, or say them with an audible voice.* Let us pray: O almighty, everlasting God, we give praise and thanks unto thy divine bounty that thou hast fed us and given us to drink with the wholesome flesh and blood of thine only Son Jesus Christ our Lord; and we humbly beseech thee that thou wouldest work in us by thy Holy Spirit, that as we have received this holy sacrament with the mouth, so we may also with firm faith apprehend and for ever retain thy divine grace, forgiveness of sins, union with Christ and everlasting life, which are therein set forth and promised. *Another prayer.* We thank thee also, Lord Jesus Christ, that thou hast refreshed us through this wholesome gift of thy body and blood; and we beseech thy mercy that thou wouldest let the same prosper in us unto a strong faith toward thee and unto fervent love among us all; who with God the Father in the unity of the Holy Ghost livest and reignest ever and eternally. *Choir:* Amen. *Then let him bow and say:* May thy body, O Lord, which we sinners have received, and the cup which we have drunk, cleave unto our inward parts; and grant that no stain of sin may remain there where so pure and holy sacraments have entered. What we have received with the mouth, O Lord, may we take with a pure mind; and of a temporal gift may it become unto us an everlasting remedy; through Christ our Lord. Amen. *Thereafter he or his deacons, both or one, shall sing the Benedicamus Domino in the tone in which the Kyrie eleison was sung; and the choir shall answer in the very same tone:* Let us say thanks unto God. *Thereafter let the priest bless the people with a loud, audible voice thus:* The Lord bless you and keep you! The Lord lighten his countenance upon you and be gracious unto you! The Lord lift up his countenance upon you and give you peace! Amen. *Or thus:* God be merciful and gracious unto us and give us his divine blessing! May he cause his countenance to shine upon us and give us his peace! Amen. *Or thus:* Bless and keep us God the Father and the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen. *Or thus:* The blessing of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost be with you and remain alway with us all! Amen. *End of the Mass with communicants.*

**Note.**

- **The thanksgiving.** Brandenburg's single German thanksgiving is split into two collects "unter einem beschluß". The second is addressed to Christ.
- ***Corpus tuum.*** It keeps Brandenburg's older wording but reads "tam pura et sancta" and drops "omnipotens deus".
- ***Quod ore sumpsimus.*** It has the full Roman text, with *et de munere temporali*.
- ***Benedicamus.*** *Benedicamus Domino* is answered "Deo dicamus gratias", the form used at Lauds and Vespers.
- **The blessings.** They are Numbers 6:24–26, Psalm 67:1 and two Trinitarian forms.

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## 7.15 Bugenhagen: the preparatory prayer, and "Hic est noster canon"

Johannes Bugenhagen's Masses keep nothing of the Canon. His Braunschweig order of 1528 (Sehling 6, I, pp. 440–442; doc 1983) runs as follows after the sermon:

- the chalice is prepared during a German hymn;
- an exhortation;
- on feasts, a Latin Preface and Sanctus;
- the Our Father, sung;
- the Verba over the bread, then communion of the bread;
- the Verba over the cup, then communion of the cup;
- the German *Agnus Dei*;
- Luther's thanksgiving collect and the Aaronic blessing.

Bugenhagen's own comment on the Preface: "wente de exhortatie vamme sacramente is de rechte prefatie, dat is eyne vohrrede" ("for the exhortation on the sacrament is the true Preface, that is, a foreword"). The same order says of the Canon that

it is "tosamende flicket van velen stucken alse eyn praccherhoyke" ("patched together out of many pieces like a beggar's cloak", p. 440).

What his later orders do keep is a **preparatory prayer of the priest at the altar step** (*Stufengebet*). It is the evangelical counterpart of the Roman *Iudica me*, *Confiteor* and *Aufer a nobis*, and it is what is usually meant by "Bugenhagen's preparatory prayer". It appears in three forms.

Bugenhagen's northern Mass as a family of ordo is treated in Chapter 2, §2.4.2.

#### 7.15.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543

Sehling 6, I/2, pp. 54–55 (eko.db doc 1972). The order came out of the visitation of 1542 by Bugenhagen, Antonius Corvinus and Martin Görlitz (Sehling 6, I, p. 12). It prints the German Benedictus and a psalm at the beginning of the Mass. The prayer is said while they are sung.

> *Under dem psalme edder gesange geyt de prester vor dat altar, knyet sick mit dem köster und bedet vor sick und vor dat volk und vor alle nött der christenheit also:* Pater noster etc. *De köster secht:* Amen. Domine non secundum peccata nostra etc. *De köster:* Neque secundum iniquitates nostras etc. Domine ne memineris etc. *De köster:* Cito anticipent etc. Adiuva nos Deus etc. *De köster:* Et propicius esto etc. *Darna steyt de prester up und geyt vor dat altar, schicket sick tho singen und tho lesen.*

*During the psalm or hymn the priest goeth before the altar, kneeleth down with the sexton, and prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom thus:* Our Father, etc. *The sexton saith:* Amen. O Lord, deal not with us after our sins, etc. *The sexton:* Neither reward us according to our iniquities, etc. O Lord, remember not, etc. *The sexton:* Let thy mercies speedily prevent us, etc. Help us, O God, etc. *The sexton:* And be merciful, etc. *Thereafter the priest standeth up, and goeth before the altar, and prepareth himself to sing and to read.*

**Note.**

- **The versicles in full.** The versicles and responses are the Lenten tract *Domine, non secundum*, from Ps 103:10 and Ps 79:8–9, which also stands in the *preces* of the Office:
  - *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra facias nobis: neque secundum iniquitates nostras retribuas nobis.*
  - *Domine, ne memineris iniquitatum nostrarum antiquarum: cito anticipent nos misericordiae tuae, quia pauperes facti sumus nimis.*
  - *Adiuva nos, Deus, salutaris noster: et propter gloriam nominis tui, Domine, libera nos: et propitius esto peccatis nostris, propter nomen tuum.*
- **What it replaces.** The Roman prayers at the foot of the altar were said by the priest and server in dialogue: Ps 43 *Iudica me*, the *Confiteor* and *Misereatur*, the versicles *Adiutorium nostrum* and *Deus, tu conversus*, and *Aufer a nobis*. Bugenhagen keeps the form: kneeling, in dialogue with the sexton as server, during the opening chant. He replaces the confession of sin with the Lord's Prayer and the tract's plea for mercy, "vor sick und vor dat volk und vor alle nött der christenheit". Sehling's editor calls it a "Stufengebet".

The rest of the Wolfenbüttel Sacrament, for comparison with the orders above:

> *Na dissem alle geschut de gewöntlicke predige. Wen de uthe is und denn gefunden werden, de sick berichten laten willen, schal de prester bereiden brod und wyn na dem talle syner communicanten und scholen sick thom altar vorvögen und ordentlick tho der communion schikken de manne thor rechten, de frouen und jungfrouen thor lüchter syden. Denne so kert sick de prester thom volke, welck sick berichten lathen wil und lest en vohr eine vormaninge thom sacramente also:* Myne allerlevesten, uns werd stedes dorch de predige des evangelii Christi vohrgeholden, dat wy van uns sülvest unweten, arme sündere und verlaren sind. […] He secht: Dit is myn lyff, dat vor ju gegeven werd. Dit is myn blut, dat vor ju uthgelaten werd tho vorgevinge der sünden. Sülck schole gy loven. He gebüt avers: Nemet hen und ethet. Drinket alle daruth und gedenket myner. Sülck schole gy dohn na syner gnaden worde und bevehele. Amen.

*After all this the customary sermon taketh place. When it is out, and there are found such as will be communicated, the priest shall prepare bread and wine according to the number of his communicants; and they shall betake themselves to the altar and orderly dispose themselves to the communion, the men on the right, the women and maidens on the candle side. Then the priest turneth to the people that will be communicated, and readeth them an exhortation to the sacrament thus:* My dearly beloved, it is

continually set before us by the preaching of the Gospel of Christ that we of ourselves are ignorant, poor and lost sinners. […] He saith: This is my body, which is given for you. This is my blood, which is shed for you for the forgiveness of sins. That shall ye believe. But he commandeth: Take and eat. Drink ye all thereout, and remember me. That shall ye do according to his gracious word and command. Amen.

**Note.**

- **"schal de prester bereiden brod und wyn"** is all that is left of the offertory, as in Braunschweig 1528 and Schleswig-Holstein 1542.
- **The exhortation** (Braunschweig 1528, pp. 443f.) is Bugenhagen's "rechte prefatie". The order also allows Luther's paraphrase of the Our Father to be read before it.
- **What follows.** The sung Our Father, the Verba over the bread, communion, the Verba over the cup, communion, the German *Agnus Dei*, Luther's thanksgiving collect ("Wy danken dy, almechtige Here Got …") and the Aaronic blessing.
- **On feasts.** In towns the priest may sing a Latin Preface (Christmas, Easter, Whitsun; the Trinity Preface on other feasts; "de quotidiana lasse men slichtes ligen alse unnödich"). The whole congregation then sings a German Sanctus, "Hillich is Got, de Vader, hillich is Got, de Sone, hillich is Got, de hilge Geist …". After it the exhortation may be left out.

### 7.15.2 Hildesheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544

Sehling 7, V, pp. 852–855 (eko.db doc 2136). This is the order for the city of Hildesheim, drawn up by Bugenhagen, Winkel and Corvinus. It has the same prayer, and at the end a private thanksgiving of the priest:

> *Int erste mach me singen vor dem introitum einen düdeschen psalm edder ledt, ut der hilligen schrift gemaket. Under dem gesange geit de prester vor dat altar unde kneet sick mit dem oppermanne, bedet vor sick unde vor dat volk unde vor alle nodt der christenheit also:* Pater noster etc. *De opperman secht:* Amen. Domine non secundum peccata nostra etc. *De opperman:* Neque secundum iniquitates nostras etc. Domine ne memineris etc. *De opperman:* Cito anticipent nos etc. Adiuva nos Deus etc. *De opperman:* Et propitius esto etc. *Darna steit de prester up unde geit vor dat altar, schicket sick to singen unde to lesen.* […] *So hevet de scholmester an einen düdeschen, korten psalm, edder wat öhme gefellich unde darmede ein ende etc. Dewile överst de sank waret, tüt sick de prediger ut unde lecht dat missgewand tohope, kneet wedder nedder vor dem altare unde danket Godde hemelick vor sick sülvest.*

*First one may sing before the introit a German psalm or hymn made out of the holy Scripture. During the singing the priest goeth before the altar and kneeleth down with the sexton, prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom thus:* Our Father, etc. *The sexton saith:* Amen. O Lord, deal not with us after our sins, etc. *The sexton:* Neither reward us according to our iniquities, etc. O Lord, remember not, etc. *The sexton:* Let thy mercies speedily prevent us, etc. Help us, O God, etc. *The sexton:* And be merciful, etc. *Thereafter the priest standeth up and goeth before the altar, and prepareth himself to sing and to read.* […] *Then the schoolmaster beginneth a short German psalm, or what pleaseth him, and therewith an end, etc. But while the singing lasteth, the preacher unvesteth and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.*

**Note.**

- **The sexton** is the "opperman" (*Opfermann*, the offertory-man).
- **The closing thanksgiving** is the evangelical form of the priest's private thanksgiving after Mass (*Gratiarum actio post missam*: *Trium puerorum*, Ps 150 and collects), still said kneeling and "hemelick".

### 7.15.3 Schleswig-Holstein, *Christlyke Kercken Ordeninge*, 1542

Sehling 23, A, Nr. 7, p. 89 (eko.db doc 1576). This is the Low German form of the Danish *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* (1537), which Bugenhagen drew up. The text is fixed only by rubric:

> *Ein Prester, de Misse holden wil, valle yn de kne vor dem Altar und lese by sick Confiteor. He bidde vor de Prediger des Evangelii, vor den Könninck unde vor dat Rike, ock vor desse Förstendöme. Darna handel he de Misse na older gewanheit. Doch dat he se nicht beflecke mit dem Titel des offerhandes effte werckes, wo denne der Papisten Hüchelie unde honspottinge vorhen gewesen ys.* […] *Dewile averst de Sanck wäret, thut sick de Prester uth unnde lecht dat Missegewandt tho hope, Knyet wedderumme nedder vor den Altar unde dancket Gade hemelick vor sick sulvest.*

*A priest that will hold Mass, let him fall on his knees before the altar and read by himself the Confiteor. Let him pray for the preachers of the Gospel, for the King and for the realm, and also for these duchies. Thereafter let him conduct the Mass according to the old custom; yet so that he defile it not with the title of sacrifice or work, as the hypocrisy and mockery of the papists hath been heretofore.* […] *But while the singing lasteth, the priest unvesteth and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.*

**Note.**

- **The *Confiteor*** is kept in its Roman place and posture, said privately ("by sick").
- **The intercession** (preachers, king, realm, duchies) gathers into the preparation what the Canon's *Te igitur* and *Memento* had prayed for.
- **"na older gewanheit".** The Mass is to be kept "according to the old custom", but without "the title of sacrifice or work".
- **At the Verba.** The Latin *Ordinatio* allows an elevation at this point, "si ita visum fuerit ministro", with the bells.

#### 7.15.4 "Hic est noster canon"

Bugenhagen names the evangelical replacement of the Canon in two places. The first is the *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum* for cathedral chapters and monasteries. Sehling prints it among the Pomeranian orders (4, pp. 345–352, doc 1857). Its Danish hymn incipits show it belongs with the Danish *Ordinatio*. The second is its Low German form in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (p. 147).

> Post verbum dei admoneantur, ut orent pro omnibus omnium hominum conditionibus, pro ecclesia, pro pace, salute etc. Hic est noster canon. Papistae autem heac seria cum suis mendaciis simul congresserunt in ullum occultum missae canonem.

> Na der Predige schollen de Lüde vormanet werden, dat se bidden vor allerley Stende der werlt, vor de Kerckheren, vor einen frede, vor de salicheit etc. Unde datsulvige gebedt ys unse Canon. Averst de Papisten hebben solck ernstlick dinck mit eren lügen thosamende geflicket yn den heimeliken Canon der Misse.

After the word of God let them be admonished to pray for all conditions of all men, for the Church, for peace, salvation, etc. This is our Canon. But the papists have patched these serious things together with their lies into that secret Canon of the Mass.

After the sermon the people shall be admonished to pray for all manner of estates of the world, for the pastors, for peace, for salvation, etc. And that same prayer is our Canon. But the papists have patched such an earnest thing together with their lies into the secret Canon of the Mass.

**Note.**

- **The Canon has become the general prayer.** For Bugenhagen, the Church's intercession after the sermon *is* the Canon: the prayer "pro ecclesia … pro pace" that *Te igitur* had once been. The German Masses of Strasbourg (§7.5.1–7.5.2) and Döber (§7.8.11) put the same intercession into the Canon's own place after the Sanctus. Bugenhagen moves it to after the sermon, where the general prayers of the later church orders stand.
- **"in ullum"** is Sehling's print, for *in illum*.

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## Appendix 7.A The Canon critique of 1533/1540/1543

This is Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Sehling 13, I.2, p. 65. Sehling traces it through Brandenburg 1540 (Sehling 3, 64f.) to Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, 183f.). These are the register references 11:183 and 13:65. Sehling's footnotes to the three quotations give the Canon's own words; they are supplied here in brackets.

> Und ob die widersacher wolten sagen (wie sie dann durch angezeigte schrift gedrungen werden, wann sie nicht gar verstockt sein), sie opferten nicht, sonder meineten nur ein gedechtnus und representation des ersten opfers zu machen, so sol man inen antworten; Wenn sie die wort, darmit sie gestracks opfern (furnemblich aber dise: „die wir dir opfern für dein heilige christliche kirchen etc." [*Te igitur*: … rogamus, ut accepta habeas … haec … sacrificia …, quae tibi offerimus pro ecclesia tua sancta catholica] und: „Wir bitten dich, du wöllest dises opfer gnediglich annemen und uns von der ewigen verdamnus erlösen etc." [*Hanc igitur*: Hanc igitur oblationem, quaesumus, ut placatus accipias … atque ab aeterna damnatione nos eripi … iubeas] und: „Wir opfern deiner herrlichen majestat etc." [*Unde et memores*: … offerimus praeclarae maiestati tuae …]) heraus tun und setzen darfur: Wir gedenken des opfers deines einigen Sons etc., so wöllen

> wirs glauben, das ihnen ernst sei, und sie seinds auch schuldig zu tun und könnens on ergernus wol ausrichten. Dann haben sie Kilianum und Totnanum umb gelts willen hinein gesetzt, das nichts nutz ist, so sollen sie nun billich umbs glaubens und der warheit willen dise wort endern, da es not ist.

And if the adversaries would say (as they are then driven by the scripture alleged, if they be not altogether hardened) that they offer not, but mean only to make a memorial and representation of the first sacrifice, then shall one answer them thus: if they take out the words wherewith they plainly offer (but chiefly these: "which we offer unto thee for thy holy Christian Church, etc.", and: "We beseech thee that thou wouldest graciously accept this sacrifice and deliver us from eternal damnation, etc.", and: "We offer unto thy glorious majesty, etc."), and set in place thereof, "We remember the sacrifice of thine only Son, etc.", then will we believe that they are in earnest; and they are also bound to do it, and can well perform it without offence. For if they have set Kilian and Totnan therein for money's sake, which is of no profit, they should now rightly, for faith's and truth's sake, change these words where it is needful.

**Note.** The three passages condemned are the offering clauses of *Te igitur*, *Hanc igitur* and *Unde et memores*. Sehling's note explains "Kilian and Totnan". The Würzburg missal (Speciale missarum, Würzburg 1495) added these Würzburg martyrs, with Colonat, and confessors to the saints of the **embolism** *Libera nos*: "nec non et sanctis martiribus tuis Chiliano, Colanato, Totnano sanctisque confessoribus tuis Martino, Nicolao, Burchardo, Benedicto". The argument is that a Canon already changed for local saints can be changed for the truth.

The orders in this file answer the demand in two ways:

- **Worms 1524** (Moderate Reformed) had already done what the critique asks. It kept the Canon but turned each offering into prayer: "anbieten unser demütiges gebet" (§7.6.8); "wöllest dich unser und aller unser gebet … annemen" (§7.6.5).
- **Osiander's prayer in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543** (§7.14.2) does it half-way. It "brings" the gifts before the divine majesty, but offers bread and wine, not the body and blood.

# Chapter 8. Hymn Practice

This chapter covers where hymns were sung in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks four questions:

- In which parts of the Mass, the offices and the occasional rites (baptism, weddings, the sick, burial, ordination) did the orders put hymns?
- Which hymns did they assign to each of these places?
- Was a given place filled by one fixed hymn, by a choice among a handful, or by a hymn that changed with the season, the feast, the Sunday gospel or the sermon?
- What reasons did the orders give for their choices?

It deals with the slots of the service, not with the propers as such. Where a hymn took the place of a proper (introit, gradual, alleluia, sequence, offertory, communion), the replacement is recorded. Troped, farced and paraphrased ordinaries (Kyrie, Gloria, Credo, Sanctus, Agnus Dei) are treated in full.

This chapter is separate from the hymn database, `hymns.db` (Introduction), which holds the per-Sunday and per-feast hymn tables. The tables it holds (Pomerania 1569, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Hof 1592, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hohenlohe 1596, Nördlingen 1579 and Heilbronn 1543) are referred to here but not repeated.

The findings are summarised in §8.1, and the method is described in §8.2. §8.3 sets out the slots in outline. §§8.4–8.15 follow the slots of the Mass in order. §8.16 covers the offices (with the *Benedicamus* and the old festal songs such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem*), the catechism and the weekday services, and §8.17 the occasional rites. §8.18 gathers the reasons the orders give. §8.19 is a concordance of every order quoted. Appendix 8.A condenses the "Compare by day" sheet of `hymns.xlsx` into one table: the chief hymn (*Hauptlied*) of each Sunday and feast in the old sources, with its original, literal English and common English titles and its witnesses.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the order of the Mass in which the slots stand: Chapter 2, §§2.4–2.5;
- the Latin propers that the hymns replaced: Chapter 4, §§4.3–4.9;
- the organ in alternation with choir and people: Chapter 9, §9.3;
- the offices and the catechism service in which the office hymns were sung: Chapter 10, §§10.7, 10.10;
- the Litany: Chapter 13, §13.22;
- the feasts and seasons: Chapter 12, §§12.10, 12.12;
- the prayer before the sermon and the sermon itself: Chapter 11, §11.10;
- the rites at which hymns were sung (baptism, marriage, burial and ordination): Chapter 13, §§13.3, 13.7, 13.9, 13.10.

## 8.1 Summary of findings

### 8.1.1 The main findings

**1. Most hymn slots were fixed.** In nearly every order a given place in the service was filled by one hymn, or by a choice among two to five. The choice was often exchanged at the high feasts for a hymn of the feast. Only one slot regularly changed from Sunday to Sunday: the hymn between the epistle and the gospel. From about 1560 a second slot joined it in some regions: the hymn after the sermon. The table in §8.1.2 sets out the pattern slot by slot.

**2. The opening of the service was a prayer for the Holy Ghost.** *Veni sancte Spiritus*, in Latin or in German ("Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott", or the prose "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle"), or "Nun bitten wir", was often sung kneeling. The Hessian *Agende* (1574, Philippist) gives the reason: "that the help and assistance of the Holy Ghost may be prayed for, for the performing of the whole service" (§8.4.1). Many orders also say plainly that the opening songs were sung "until the congregation cometh together" (§8.4.2). Some northern orders opened with the German Benedictus or the German Te Deum instead (§§8.4.3–8.4.4).

**3. Hymns took the place of the introit, the gradual, the sequence and the offertory.**

- **Introit.** A Scriptural Latin introit could be kept where a school sang it. Otherwise, and in the villages always, "a German psalm" was sung "an stat des introitus". The usual psalms were Ps 67, 51, 130, 12, 124 and 14, or "Komm heiliger Geist", usually rotated (§8.5).
- **Gradual, alleluia and sequence.** These gave way to a German psalm or hymn, often chosen by season or gospel (§8.8).
- **Offertory.** This became a German psalm sung while bread and wine were prepared and the communicants came forward (§8.11.3). In Bugenhagen's orders the creed hymn "Wir glauben all" served here, sung after the sermon (§8.9.2).
- **Communion chant.** This was replaced by the communion hymns (§8.14).
- **Particular days.** A hymn replaced the gradual at the Purification ("Mit Fried und Freud"), the sequence in Passiontide (Ps 51), and the offertory at Christmas ("Ein Kindelein so löbelich") (§§8.8.5, 8.11.3).

**4. The ordinaries were troped and paraphrased in German.**

- **Kyrie.** Troped German Kyries survive in the Low German Mass of Schleswig-Holstein (after 1526), Naumburg (1537/38), Mecklenburg (1545), Ritzebüttel (1556), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557) and Hof (1592). They were sung to the melodies of the Latin *Kyrie summum*, *paschale*, *magne Deus* and *fons bonitatis*, and graded by season. The Kyrie was also sung in three tongues, Greek, Latin and German (Prussia 1525, Riga 1530) (§8.6).
- **Gloria.** "Allein Gott in der Höh" was sung for, alternately with, or inside the Latin Gloria. In the last case the whole German hymn was inserted between *Et in terra pax* and *Laudamus te* (Wolfenbüttel 1543, Hildesheim 1544, Osnabrück 1543). "All Ehr und Lob" was the alternative (§8.7).
- **Creed.** "Wir glauben all" (§8.9).
- **Sanctus.** Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten" was usual, and a Trinitarian troped Sanctus, "Heilig ist Gott der Vater", was also sung (§8.12).
- **Agnus Dei.** "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" and "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" (§8.15).
- **Lord's Prayer and Verba.** No troped or farced Lord's Prayer or Words of Institution was found. The congregation sometimes sang Luther's "Vater unser im Himmelreich" (§8.13).

**5. At the three high feasts the Latin sequences were farced with German stanzas.** The pairs were *Grates nunc omnes* with "Gelobet seist du", *Victimae paschali* with "Christ lag in Todesbanden" (or "Christ ist erstanden"), and *Veni sancte Spiritus* with "Nun bitten wir". Choir and people, or organ and cantor, sang by turns (§8.8.3). Most other sequences were dropped as impure (§8.8.2).

**6. Before the sermon the congregation prayed in song.** The hymn was "Nun bitten wir", often begun by the preacher from the pulpit, and sung "an Gebets statt". At the high feasts the old pre-Reformation *Leisen* took its place: "Ein Kindelein so löbelich", "Christ ist erstanden", "Christ fuhr gen Himmel", "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei". Some orders sang the Lord's Prayer hymn in Lent or Advent. Several orders give the whole year as a seasonal table (§8.10).

**7. After the sermon the core hymn was "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort".** It was sung as a prayer for the word against the Pope and the Turk (Prussia 1568: "as after every sermon always"). Other choices were "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" and "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei". From the 1570s the Hanau-Lichtenberg, Hohenlohe, Öhringen, Reutlingen, Rostock and Marienhafe orders wanted a hymn that "agreeth with the sermon". Hohenlohe (1596) gave a menu under twelve doctrinal articles (§8.11.5).

**8. The communion hymns hardly changed through the century.** The core was Hus's "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", "Gott sei gelobet", "Jesaia dem Propheten" and Ps 111, followed by the German Agnus Dei. What changed was the number of hymns, measured almost everywhere by the number of communicants. Bugenhagen's orders stopped the song as soon as the distribution ended, "though a song begun be not sung out" (§8.14.3). Festal hymns, the Passion, *Discubuit*, *Pange lingua* and the Te Deum were added at the margin (§8.14).

**9. Hymns covered movements and actions.** Many orders say that the hymn is sung "while" or "meanwhile":

- the people gather (§8.4.2);
- the priest prays at the altar step (§8.4.6);
- the preacher goes up into or comes down from the pulpit (§§8.9.3, 8.10.5, 8.11.2);
- the priest "takes a little breath" (§8.11.2) or puts on his vestments (§8.11.2);
- the bread and wine are prepared (§8.11.3);
- the communicants come into the choir (§§8.11.4, 8.12.1);

- the celebrant takes off his vestments (§8.15.4).

Hof sang at baptism "that two actions may not follow one upon the other without a song" (§8.17.1).

**10. The rules for choosing a hymn grew stricter over the century.** In broad order, the reasons given were these:

- The text must be from Scripture and "pure" (§8.18.1).
- The hymn must "rhyme with the feast" and the season (§8.18.2).
- On ordinary Sundays it should "rhyme with the gospel". The rule of Pomerania 1542 and Mecklenburg 1545 lists hymns for gospels of faith and grace, of Christ's enemies, of good works, and of the use of earthly goods (§8.8.6).
- It should agree with the sermon (§§8.11.5, 8.18.3).
- In the catechism service it should be the hymn of the chief part being taught (§8.16.6).

Alongside these ran the practical reasons:

- The people should learn a few hymns well, repeated and rotated (§8.18.4).
- Luther's hymns should come first. Prussia 1568 says no new poet "can hold a candle to Luther" (§8.18.5).
- Private choice by schoolmasters and organists was to be curbed.
- Authorized cantionals were enforced: Spangenberg, Lossius, and an "unfalsified" Luther songbook (§8.18.6).
- There were limits of language, length and organ use (§§8.18.7–8.18.9).

**11. The *Benedicamus* was graded, put into German and sometimes replaced, but never troped.** No order in the corpus prescribes a *Benedicamus* troped with a festal song such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem*. The *Benedicamus* kept seasonal melodies (*in adventu*, *angelicum*, *dominicale*, *paschale* with alleluia), and was sung in German ("Last uns gesegnen den herren") at the end of the Mass or office. It could give way to a figured motet of the feast (Hof 1592) or to a German hymn, at Christmas "Dank sagen wir alle" (Nördlingen 1555, Wolfenbüttel 1569). *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs were sung next to it: upon the Magnificat (Naumburg 1537), at the entrance or going out of vespers (Pomerania 1569, Hof 1592), for the introit, and after the catechism or sermon (§§8.16.8–8.16.10).

### 8.1.2 The slots compared

"Fixed" means one hymn, or one per grade or feast. "A handful" means a named choice of two to five, often rotated. "Variable" means the hymn changed with the Sunday, gospel or sermon.

| Slot | Where it falls | Hymns usually named | How fixed |
|---|---|---|---|
| Opening (§8.4) | before the introit, or before the sermon in the Württemberg type | *Veni sancte* / "Komm heiliger Geist"; "Nun bitten"; German Benedictus; German Te Deum; Ps 51 | **fixed** or a handful; graded by feast in some orders |
| For the introit (§8.5) | first chant of the Mass | "Es woll uns Gott" (Ps 67), "Erbarm dich mein" (Ps 51), "Aus tiefer Not" (Ps 130), "Ach Gott vom Himmel" (Ps 12), "Wär Gott nicht mit uns" (Ps 124), "Komm heiliger Geist"; festal *Leisen* | **a handful**, rotated; festal exchange |
| Kyrie (§8.6) | after the introit or confession | Latin by grade; German plain or troped ("Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit", "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott", "O Herre Gott", "O Vater allmächtiger Gott") | **fixed by grade and season** |
| Gloria (§8.7) | after the Kyrie | "Allein Gott in der Höh"; "All Ehr und Lob" | **fixed**; Latin and German alternate or combine |
| Between epistle and gospel (§8.8) | the gradual, alleluia and sequence | farced sequences at the high feasts; German psalm matched to season or gospel; litany-hymn "Nim von uns" | **variable**: Sunday or seasonal tables, gospel rule |
| Creed (§8.9) | after the gospel, or after the sermon | "Wir glauben all"; sung Apostles' or Nicene Creed | **fixed**; place varies |

| Slot | Where it falls | Hymns usually named | How fixed |
|---|---|---|---|
| Before the sermon (§8.10) | after the creed or prayers; from the pulpit | "Nun bitten"; *Leisen* at feasts; Lord's Prayer hymn | **fixed with seasonal exchange** |
| After the sermon (§8.11) | after the sermon and prayers; the offertory place | "Erhalt uns"; "Es woll uns Gott"; "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei"; any German psalm; sermon-matched hymn | **a handful**, becoming **variable** in later orders |
| Sanctus (§8.12) | after the preface or exhortation | "Jesaia dem Propheten"; "Heilig ist Gott der Vater"; Latin Sanctus by grade | **fixed** |
| Lord's Prayer and Verba (§8.13) | before the distribution | "Vater unser im Himmelreich" (rare) | **fixed** or none |
| Under the communion (§8.14) | during the distribution | "Jesus Christus unser Heiland"; "Gott sei gelobet"; "Jesaia"; Ps 111; Agnus; extras by number of communicants | **fixed core**; quantity varies |
| Post-communion (§8.15) | after the distribution | "Christe, du Lamm Gottes"; "O Lamm Gottes"; "Gott sei gelobet" | **fixed** |
| Close (§8.15) | after the blessing | "Verleih uns Frieden" / *Da pacem*; "Erhalt uns"; "Es woll uns Gott"; "Sei Lob und Ehr"; "Dank sagen wir alle"; festal hymn | **a handful**; festal exchange |
| *Benedicamus* (§§8.16.8–8.16.10) | end of vespers, matins, and some Masses | Latin by grade; German "Last uns gesegnen den herren"; "Dank sagen wir alle" at Christmas; figured motet; festal songs (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*) next to it, not in it | **fixed by grade**; replaced at feasts |
| Office hymn (§8.16) | vespers, matins | Latin hymn *de tempore*, purged; German office hymns | **fixed by season** |
| Catechism service (§8.16.6) | before or after the catechism sermon | the hymn of the chief part | **fixed by the part taught** |
| Occasional rites (§8.17) | baptism, wedding, burial, ordination | "Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam"; Ps 127/128; "Mitten wir im Leben", "Mit Fried und Freud", "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben"; "Nun bitten", Te Deum | **a handful** per rite |

#### 8.1.3 How the practice changed over the century

- **1523–1535: Luther and Bugenhagen.** Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) wanted German songs near the gradual, Sanctus and Agnus. The *Deutsche Messe* (1526) filled these slots. Bugenhagen's orders (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Pomerania 1535) fixed the northern pattern:
  - German psalm or Benedictus at the start;
  - farced sequences at three feasts;
  - creed as offertory;
  - Hus's hymn and "Gott sei gelobet" at communion, stopped when the distribution ends;
  - "Christe du Lamm Gottes" after all have communicated.
- **1540s: the gospel rule and the *Leisen*.** Pomerania (1542) and Mecklenburg (1545) chose the post-epistle hymn by the matter of the gospel. The *Leisen* before the sermon became standard. Mecklenburg 1552 had the preachers sing them from the pulpit, and Lüneburg (1564), Wolfenbüttel (1569) and Oldenburg (1573) copied the rule.
- **1550s–1590s: tables, sermons, catechism and books.**
  - Sunday tables appeared (Pirna 1555, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565, Pomerania 1569, Weissenfels 1578, Mansfeld 1580, Hof 1592, Hohenlohe 1596).

  - Orders asked for hymns matched to the sermon (Hanau-Lichtenberg 1573, Öhringen 1582, Brieg 1592, Marienhafe 1593, Hohenlohe 1596).
  - Catechism hymns spread (Lippe 1571, Hoya 1581, Grubenhagen 1581).
  - Luther's hymns were defended as a canon (Prussia 1568, Harlingerland 1573/74, Hoya 1581).
  - Cantionals were imposed (Lossius, Spangenberg).
- **1607: Hessen-Kassel.** As Hesse turned Reformed, Lobwasser's psalms entered the communion. Hymn numbers were posted on boards at the church doors, and the synod asked for a table of hymns "accommodated to the texts which should be preached" (§8.18.3).

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## 8.2 Scope, sources and method

### 8.2.1 The corpus

The source is `eko.db`, the full-text database of Sehling's edition (Introduction). It holds 2,368 records in 32 digitized volumes and half-volumes, with Sehling's own subject registers. The orders run from Luther's *Formula missae* (1523) to the early seventeenth century. They cover Saxony, Thuringia, the Harz counties, Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg, the Baltic, Schleswig-Holstein, Lower Saxony, Westphalia, Hesse, the Rhineland, Franconia, Bavaria, Württemberg, Swabia, Alsace and Transylvania.

The chapter quotes 164 orders, held in 145 records. Some records hold several orders: for example, the Henneberg village reports, the Nördlingen and Schwäbisch Hall volumes, and Prussia 1544/1568.

### 8.2.2 How the corpus was searched

The search was done in three passes.

1. **Slot vocabulary.** The whole text was searched for the terms by which the orders name the places of hymns:
   - Latin: *introitus*, *pro introitu*, *loco introitus*, *post confessionem*, *post epistolam*, *graduale*, *sequentia*, *prosa*, *tractus*, *post evangelium*, *ante concionem*, *post concionem*, *offertorium*, *sub communione*, *post communionem*, *conclusio*, *pro ingressu*, *Benedicamus*, *hymnus*, *cantilena*, *cantio*.
   - German and Low German: *an stat des introitus*, *für den introitum*, *für das Halleluja*, *anstat des offertorii*, *an stat des sequenz*, *vor der predigt*, *nach der predigt*, *auf die epistel*, *nach der epistel*, *unter der communion*, *under der berichtinge*, *zum beschluss*, *tom beslute*, *deutscher Psalm*, *düdesch psalm*, *Lied*, *Leise*, *Gesang*, *Lobgesang*, *figurieren*, *orgel*.
   - The incipits of the common hymns and of the ordinaries in German ("Kyrie, Gott Vater", "Allein Gott", "All Ehr und Lob", "Wir glauben", "Jesaia dem Propheten", "Heilig ist Gott", "Christe du Lamm", "O Lamm Gottes").
2. **Registers.** Sehling's per-volume registers of *Lieder und Gesänge* were read, and every page they cite was checked.
3. **Reading the orders.** About three hundred orders with hymn material were then read in the passages around each hit. Notes were taken slot by slot, and the rites were read in full.

The chapter gives the passages that state a rule, give a reason, or show a practice clearly. Where many orders say the same thing, the earliest or clearest is quoted and the others are named.

### 8.2.3 Cautions

- **Prescription, not observation.** Church orders say what should be sung. Only a few sources report what was actually sung. The Henneberg village pastors' reports of 1562–1566 are the richest of these (Sehling 2, pp. 329–357), with the Langenburg dispute of 1592. Even these may describe what the pastor wished the visitors to read.
- **"Psalm".** In these orders *ein deutscher Psalm* means any German metrical hymn, not only a psalm paraphrase. "Aus tiefer Not" is a psalm; so is "Nun freut euch".
- **Database headings.** The database's record headings, years and numbering do not always match the orders inside them. This chapter names each order from Sehling's running heads. In particular:
  - Doc 373 (headed 1544) is the Nördlingen St George's order of 1555.
  - Doc 1955 (headed 1590) is the Hadeln order of 1526.
  - Doc 2065 (headed 1571) is the Hoya order of 1581.

  - Doc 1809 holds both the Liegnitz order of 1542 and the Brieg order of 1592.
  - Doc 1248 holds the Henneberg village orders of Belrieth, Goldlauter, Herpf and Meiningen. The running head spells Goldlauter "Groldlauter".
  - Doc 1249 holds Obermassfeld and Queienfeld. A passage on p. 344–345 belongs to Queienfeld, though the running head of p. 345 names Ritschenhausen.
  - Doc 1250 holds Suhl, Sulzfeld and Wasungen (p. 356 is Wasungen, not Vachdorf).
  - Doc 84 is the Eisfeld visitation order of 1554, and doc 78 the Dresden Kreuzkirche order of 1574.
  - Doc 1262 holds the Anhalt order of 3 August 1548 and the *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge* of before 8 February 1551.
  - Doc 2204 holds two Goslar chapter orders, of 1560 (p. 319–321) and August 1566 (p. 322–323).
  - Doc 2003, 2009 and 2017 (Lüneburg) are in half-volume 6/1.
- **Sehling's summaries.** For Danzig (1557) Sehling prints a summary with quotations, and the chapter quotes it as such.
- **Apparatus.** Footnotes, variant readings and editorial notes are interleaved in the database text. They have been removed from quotations. Where a quotation crosses a page break or a footnote, the break is marked "[…]".
- **Later additions.** A few passages are later additions printed with an earlier order. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg rule on the burial of the unrepentant (§8.17.4) is one; the 1577 variants of Kurpfalz 1556 (§8.12.1) are another. They are marked as such.
- **Not repeated here.** The per-Sunday hymn tables already extracted into `hymns.db` are described in the Introduction (The hymn database) and are not repeated.

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## 8.3 The hymn slots in outline

### 8.3.1 What the orders called the slots

Most orders name a slot by where it falls: before or after something, or in the place of something. The Latin orders use *introitus*, *post confessionem*, *post epistolam*, *post evangelium*, *ante concionem*, *post concionem*, *sub communione* and *conclusio*. The German and Low German orders say *vor der predigt*, *nach der predigt*, *unter der communion* and *zum beschluss*. The replacement of a chant is always marked: *an stat des introitus*, *für das Halleluja*, *anstat des offertorii*, *an stat des sequenz*, *pro introitu*, *loco Et in terra*.

The fullest set of slot labels is the three-week hymn plan of **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 17 August 1565** (Sehling 18, p. 337). Its first Sunday after Trinity reads:

> Introitus: Nun freudt euch, lieben [Christen gemein], die erst melodi. Kom, heilliger Geist. Post Confessionem: Das zweyt Kyrie. Post Epistolam: Ich glaub an gott etc. Ante Contionem: Nun bitten wir etc. Post Contionem: Herr, wie lanng wilt vergessen etc. Conclussio: Christum, unnsern Heylanndt.

*Introitus*: "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," the first melody; "Come, Holy Ghost." *After the confession*: the second Kyrie. *After the epistle*: "I believe in God," etc. *Before the sermon*: "Now pray we," etc. *After the sermon*: "Lord, how long wilt thou forget," etc. *Conclusion*: "Christ, our Saviour."

The Mass order of **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 425) numbers the same slots. The eighth is the German hymn to the Holy Ghost before the sermon, sung kneeling:

> VIII. Organicen cantilenam germanicam ad Spiritum Sanctum directam: Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist etc. incipit (vel etiam in cantu figurali mutetam aliquam). Illa cantilena germanica genibus flexis a tribus choris continuatur.

Eighthly, the organist beginneth the German song directed to the Holy Ghost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. (or else some motet in figured song). That German song is continued by the three choirs upon bended knees.

### 8.3.2 Luther's two orders

Luther's *Formula missae* wished for German songs "near the gradual, the Sanctus and the Agnus Dei", and said that the poets to write them were lacking. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 8–9):

> Cantica velim etiam nobis esse vernacula quam plurima, quae populus sub missa cantaret, vel iuxta gradualia, item iuxta Sanctus et Agnus dei. Quis enim dubitat, eas olim fuisse voces totius populi, quae nunc solus chorus cantat vel respondet episcopo benedicenti? […] Sed poetae nobis desunt, aut nondum cogniti sunt, qui pias et spirituales cantilenas (ut Paulus vocat) nobis concinnent, quae dignae sint in ecclesia dei frequentari.

I would also that we had as many songs as may be in the vulgar tongue, which the people might sing during the Mass, either next to the graduals, and likewise next to the Sanctus and Agnus Dei. For who doubteth that these were once the voices of the whole people, which now the choir alone singeth, or answereth to the bishop when he blesseth? […] But poets are wanting to us, or are not yet known, which might make us godly and spiritual songs (as Paul calleth them), such as be worthy to be used often in the church of God.

Three years later the *Deutsche Messe* had its slots filled. It opens with a German psalm to the first tone, puts a German hymn after the epistle and the German creed after the gospel. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Zum anfang aber singen wir ein geistlich lied oder einen deudschen psalmen in primo tono auf die weise wie folget. „Ich will den Herrn loben alle zeit."

But at the beginning we sing a spiritual song or a German psalm in the first tone, after the manner following: "I will bless the Lord at all times."

> Auf die epistel singet man ein deudsch lied: 'Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist'. oder sonst eins, und das mit dem ganzen chor. Darnach lieset er das evangelion in quinto tono […] Nach dem evangelio singt die ganze kirche den glauben zu deudsch: Wir gleuben all an einen gott.

After the epistle a German song is sung, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or some other, and that with the whole choir. Then he readeth the gospel in the fifth tone […] After the gospel the whole church singeth the creed in German: "We all believe in one God."

At the communion the *Deutsche Messe* allows the German Sanctus, "Gott sei gelobet" or Hus's hymn. These three were for the whole century the core of the communion slot (§8.14) (Sehling 1, p. 15):

> Und die weil singe das deudsche sanctus oder das lied: Gott sey globet oder Johans Hussen lied: Jhesus Christus unser heiland. Darnach segene man den kilch und gebe den selbigen auch und singe, was ubrig ist von obgenanten liedern oder das deudsch Agnus dei.

And the while let the German Sanctus be sung, or the song "God be praised," or John Hus's song, "Jesus Christ our Saviour." Thereafter let the cup be blessed and given likewise, and let that be sung which remaineth of the aforenamed songs, or the German Agnus Dei.

#### 8.3.3 A whole service in hymns

Where there was no school to sing Latin, nearly every part of the service became a German hymn. The village order of the city of Braunschweig lists them in order. **Braunschweig, *Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern*, undated** (Sehling 6/1, p. 473):

> Sal erstlick der pfarher mit dem opfermann und ganzem volk singen: Kum heiliger Geist, Here Godt etc. 2. Damach das Kirieleison und et in terra deutsch, wie es Doctor Martinus vordeutschet hat. 3. Darauf sal der pfarher die collecten und epistel lesen. 4. ALßdann sol der opfermann mit dem volk das Vaterunser singen, auch wie es Doctor Martinus gemacht hat. 5. Nach diesem sal der pfarher dem volk die funf haubtstucke des catechismi […] vorlesen. 6. Darauf sal der opfermann mit dem volk singen erstlick den glauben, darnach: Nhun piten wir den heiligen Geist. 7. Dan sal der pfarher das evangelium von der kanzel lesen und die predigt darauf thim. 8. Nach der predig sal der opfermann mit dem volk dat Sanctus Esaie deutsch singen. 9. Darnach sal der pfarher die vormanung an die communicanten lesen und das Vaterunser und die verba coene so pald darauf singen deutsch. 10. Unter der communion sal der opfermann mit dem volk singen: Jesus Christus ader Godt sei gelobt ein Sontag umb den andern, wen man des Hern abentmal helt.

First the pastor shall sing with the sexton and all the people "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc. 2. Thereafter the Kyrie and *Et in terra* in German, as Doctor Martin hath put them into German. 3. Thereupon the pastor shall read the collects and the epistle. 4. Then shall the sexton with the people sing the Our Father, also as Doctor Martin hath made it. 5. After this the pastor shall read to the people the five chief parts of the catechism […]. 6. Thereupon the sexton shall sing with the people first the creed,

thereafter "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." 7. Then shall the pastor read the gospel from the pulpit and preach the sermon thereon. 8. After the sermon the sexton shall sing with the people the Sanctus of Isaiah in German. 9. Thereafter the pastor shall read the exhortation to the communicants, and straightway thereafter sing the Our Father and the words of the Supper in German. 10. During the communion the sexton shall sing with the people "Jesus Christ" or "God be praised," one Sunday after the other, when the Lord's Supper is held.

The same order closes with "Es wolt uns Gott genedig sein" and "Erhalt uns, Herr" on alternate Sundays (§8.15.3).

#### 8.3.4 Three shapes of service

The slots fall differently in three kinds of service. The hymns in each kind are much alike.

| | **Mass-shaped (Saxony, Bugenhagen's northern orders, Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg, Hesse (Moderate Reformed))** | **Preaching service with communion (Württemberg and its derivatives, Kurpfalz 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken, Baden, Strasbourg)** | **Village Mass without a school** |
|---|---|---|---|
| Opening | Latin introit, or German psalm in its place; often *Veni sancte* or "Komm heiliger Geist" first | "Komm heiliger Geist", "Nun bitten" or a German psalm "der zeit gemeß" | "Komm heiliger Geist" or a German psalm |
| Kyrie, Gloria | Latin, German, or troped German Kyrie; "Allein Gott" for or with *Et in terra* | none | German Kyrie; "Allein Gott" |
| After the epistle | sequence, alleluia or German psalm; farced sequence at the three high feasts | none | German psalm or hymn "de tempore" |
| Creed | "Wir glauben all" after the gospel, or after the sermon | sometimes after the sermon | "Wir glauben all" |
| Before the sermon | "Nun bitten"; the old *Leisen* at the high feasts | the opening hymn serves | "Nun bitten" |
| After the sermon | a psalm-hymn, "Erhalt uns", or a hymn in the place of the offertory | a German psalm or the creed while the pastor goes to the altar | "Es woll uns Gott" or "Erhalt uns" |
| Communion | German Sanctus, "Jesus Christus unser Heiland", "Gott sei gelobet", Ps 111, O Lamm Gottes | "Gott sei gelobet", "Jesus Christus", German Sanctus | the same |
| Close | "Christe du Lamm Gottes", "Verleih uns Frieden", "Erhalt uns", festal hymn | "Erhalt uns", "Verleih uns Frieden" | "Erhalt uns" |

The Württemberg shape begins with a hymn, then the sermon, then the communion. There is no introit, Kyrie, Gloria or sequence to replace. In its orders the whole weight of hymn choice falls on the hymns before and after the sermon and during the distribution. The *Kirchenordnung* of 1553 (Sehling 16, p. 252):

> So dann das Nachtmal Christi auff ein Sontag oder andern Feyrtag in der kirchen zuhalten fürgenommn würdt, soll anfenglich das gsang: Komm heiliger geist, etc., Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, etc. oder sonst ein teutscher Psalm oder geistlich lied, sonderlich der zeit gemeß, gesungen werden. Nach disem gsang soll die gemein predig geschehen.

When, then, the Supper of Christ is purposed to be held in the church upon a Sunday or other holy day, the song "Come, Holy Ghost," etc., "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., or else a German psalm or spiritual song, especially one agreeable to the season, shall be sung at the beginning. After this song the common sermon shall be held.

The Bugenhagen orders give the plainest reason for all these German songs. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 491), after listing the parts of the Mass:

> Solck alle geschüt dat meiste to düden umme des volkes willen, de wile Christus gebaden hefft. Solck dot to miner gedechtenisse.

All this is done for the most part in German for the people's sake, since Christ hath commanded: "This do in remembrance of me."

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## 8.4 The opening of the service

Before the introit, or instead of it, stood a hymn or chant that asked for the Holy Ghost, or a German canticle. These opening pieces are the most fixed of all the slots. The choice is nearly always between the Latin antiphon *Veni sancte Spiritus*, its German form "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott", and "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist". A second group opens with a German canticle: the Benedictus, the Te Deum, or Psalm 51.

### 8.4.1 *Veni sancte Spiritus* and "Komm heiliger Geist"

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) gives the reason. The whole service is asked of the Holy Ghost at its beginning, on bended knees. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

> Erstlich singen die schuler mit gebogenen knien: Komm heiliger Geist etc., damit die hülfe und beistand des heiligen Geistes zu verrichtung des ganzen kirchendienstes gebeten wird. 2. Darnach wird gesungen der introitus de trinitate oder de tempore auf Nativitatis, Resurrectionis und Pentecostes. 3. Hierauf folget das Kyrie und Et in terra.

First the scholars sing upon bended knees "Come, Holy Ghost," etc., that the help and assistance of the Holy Ghost may be prayed for, for the performing of the whole service of the church. 2. Thereafter is sung the introit of the Trinity, or of the season at the Nativity, the Resurrection and Pentecost. 3. Hereupon followeth the Kyrie and *Et in terra*.

The order of the village of Bruchhausen in the abbey lands of Corvey (1603) copies this sentence word for word (Sehling 21, p. 244).

At Hof the German forms were sung kneeling by the whole choir whenever the organ was silent. There were two of them: "Komm, du herzlich Tröster" (the German *Veni sancte Spiritus* sequence) and Luther's "Komm, heiliger Geist, Herre Gott". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 424):

> Quotiescunque organi pneumatici usus est nullus; totus chorus introitui praemittit: Veni, sancte etc. Kom, du herzlich tröster etc. germanice genibus flexis. Hoc absoluto incipit introitus. Potest introitui quoque praemitti cantilena d. Lutheri: Kom, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott etc.

As oft as there is no use of the organ, the whole choir setteth before the introit *Veni, sancte*, etc., "Come, thou heartfelt Comforter," etc., in German, with bended knees. This being ended, the introit beginneth. Doctor Luther's song, "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc., may also be set before the introit.

Soest, whose order follows Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order, had three boys sing it kneeling at the altar. **Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 22, p. 450):

> Up etlike tide mach men dree kleyne Jungen, gekneyt vor dem Altar, dat Veni sancte spiritus Dütsch edder latyn singen lathen vor der Mysse, darup eyne Dütssche Collecta.

At certain times three little boys may be made to sing, kneeling before the altar, the *Veni sancte Spiritus* in German or Latin before the Mass, thereupon a German collect.

In the late Verden order the antiphon is the priest's preparation at the altar, with versicle and collect. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 155):

> Erstlich, wann der priester oder pfarrer vor den altar getretten, so soll der chor die antiphen Veni, sancte Spiritus anfahen. Darnach soll der priester singen: Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur. Der chor soll antworten: Et renovabis faciem terrae.

First, when the priest or pastor is come before the altar, the choir shall begin the antiphon *Veni, sancte Spiritus*. Thereafter the priest shall sing: *Emitte Spiritum et creabuntur*. The choir shall answer: *Et renovabis faciem terrae*.

Some orders grade the opening hymn by feast. At Nördlingen the three stanzas of "Komm heiliger Geist" belonged to the high feasts. On other feasts and on Sundays all the stanzas of "Nun bitten" were sung, by two choirs, the school and the people, while the celebrant made his confession. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 311):

> Indes sollen zwen chore - einer der schulen, der ander des volks - an hohen festen singen umb einander Kum, hailiger Geist, alle drei gesetze aus. An andern festen aber und suntagen Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Gaist mit allen seinen gesetzen.

Meanwhile two choirs, one of the school, the other of the people, shall sing by turns on high feasts "Come, Holy Ghost," all three stanzas through. But on other feasts and on Sundays, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," with all its stanzas.

At Reutlingen the same pair of hymns ran from the last bell until the preacher was in the pulpit. **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 49):

> An dem sontag zur hauptpredig sollen schulmaister und provisor sampt den knaben, nach dem das ander zaichen gelitten worden, in die kirchen ghon und daselbst an statt des introitus ainen, zwen oder mehr gewonliche psalmen singen und zu letst gleich under oder nach dem zusamen leuthen den gesang: Kom, hailiger gaist, oder: Nun pithen wir den hailigen gaist etc., biß der prediger auff die cantzel gät.

On the Sunday, at the chief sermon, the schoolmaster and the usher with the boys shall go into the church after the second bell hath been rung, and there, in the stead of the introit, sing one, two or more customary psalms, and at the last, either during or after the ringing together, the song "Come, Holy Ghost," or "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., until the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

The prose German form of the antiphon, "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle die Herzen", was sung to the Latin melody. On the Henneberg prayer days it followed the litany and covered the preacher's going up into the pulpit. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 311):

> und wenn dieselbige geendet, als denn darauf das deutsche Kom heiliger geist, erfülle die herzen, etc. nach den noten des lateinischen Veni sancte spiritus gesungen werden, unter diesem gesang sol der prediger auf den predigstuel sich verfügen.

and when the same is ended, then thereupon the German "Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts," etc. shall be sung after the notes of the Latin *Veni sancte Spiritus*; during this song the preacher shall betake himself up into the pulpit.

#### 8.4.2 Singing while the people gather

A reason given again and again for the opening songs is plain: the people were still coming in. The Dortmund order even defines the introit this way. **Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554** (Sehling 21, p. 208):

> Introitus ys unde schal syn ein Psalm edder ein ander Geistlick lavesanck, den men singet, dewile dat volck yngheit unde sick ynn de Kercke vorsamelt, dar he ock den namen van hefft.

The introit is, and shall be, a psalm or another spiritual song of praise, which is sung while the people go in and gather themselves into the church, from which also it hath its name.

**Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 925), defending the Latin chants against those who would have no ceremonies:

> warümb solte man einen reinen introitum, Kyrieeleyson, Gloria in excelsis und das Et in terra, bis die gemeine zusamenkeme, nicht singen und bleiben lassen? Solchs kan ich zwar fur meine person nicht finden.

Why should one not sing, and let remain, a pure introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis* and the *Et in terra*, until the congregation were come together? For my own person I can indeed find no reason for it.

**Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 248):

> Erstlich, bis die gemein zusamenkompt, singt man ein psalm oder 2 nach gelegenheit eines iglichen orts.

First, until the congregation cometh together, a psalm or two are sung, according to the occasion of every place.

**Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 513), for the weekday sermons:

> praemittantur etiam singulis concionibus aliquot Germanicae cantilenae, donec populus confluat.

Let there also be set before every sermon some German songs, until the people flock together.

**Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 396). In the villages, where the people lived far apart, the Kyrie itself served while they gathered. On the high feasts a hymn of the feast took the place of the introit:

> nachdem die Leute hin und wider fern von einander zerstrewet wohnen, mit dem Teutschen oder Lateinischen Kyrie, bis die Gemein zusammen kömpt, anfahen. Aber auff den Hohen Festagen sol für den Introitum ein Geistlich Lied nach gelegenheit des Festes gesungen werden. Demnach sol volgen: Allein Gott in der höhe sey Ehre.

Forasmuch as the folk dwell here and there scattered far from one another, [he shall] begin with the German or Latin Kyrie until the congregation come together. But upon the high feast days a spiritual song according to the occasion of the feast shall be sung for the introit. Thereafter shall follow "To God alone on high be glory."

A Henneberg pastor wrote in his report that without communicants a psalm took the place of the Kyrie and *Et in terra*, "that the people might meanwhile come together". **Belrieth and Einhausen (Henneberg), *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 330):

> So aber keine communicanten furhanden sind, las ich erstlich an stat des kyrie und Et in terra ein psalm singen, das sich das volk in des zusamen bringe.

But when no communicants are present, I cause first, in the stead of the Kyrie and *Et in terra*, a psalm to be sung, that the people may meanwhile gather themselves together.

Bremen had the sexton see that German hymns were sung while the last bell rang. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 464):

> schal als denn de Köster bestüren, dat yn der Kercken gesungen werde ein ledt, Alse: Nu ys dat heil uns kamen her, Nu frouwet juw leven Christen gemene, Unde Veni Sancte spiritus Düdesch edder Latin, alse me wil dat laste teken lüden.

Then shall the sexton see to it that a song be sung in the church, as "Now is salvation come to us," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," and *Veni Sancte Spiritus* in German or Latin, when the last sign is to be rung.

**Goslar, *Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes* in the chapter church of SS. Simon and Jude, 1560** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 320), at the Sunday vespers:

> oder sollen die leuthe, so sich in der predigtt samlen, christliche loebgesinge singen, biß das der seyer zwey slechtt.

or the people that gather for the sermon shall sing Christian songs of praise until the clock strike two.

The cost of this practice was noticed. The Mansfeld *Agenda* complained that Luther's hymns were being forgotten because they were sung only at the start, before the people were there, while the towns sang Latin and figured music. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580**, article XVIII (Sehling 2, p. 234):

> Wir befinden, das leider d. Luthers, des teuren mans gottes und letzten propheten deutsches landes schöne psalmen und anderer fürtrefflicher leute geistreiche deutsche lieder an vielen orten also in abfall und vergessen komen, das die jungen hernach wachsende leute wenig von denselbigen wissen. Und kömpt solches daher, das dieselben gar wenig und seiden oder etwa im anfange des ampts, ehe die leute zusamen komen, in der kirchen gesungen werden, oder auch das in den stedten am meisten die lateinischen gesenge und musica figuralis gehalten werden.

We find that, alas, the fair psalms of Doctor Luther, the dear man of God and last prophet of the German land, and the spiritual German songs of other excellent men, are in many places so fallen into disuse and forgetting that the young folk growing up after know little of them. And this cometh thereof, that they are sung in the church very little and seldom, or perchance at the beginning of the office, before the people come together; or also that in the towns the Latin songs and figured music are for the most part kept.

### 8.4.3 The German Benedictus

Bugenhagen's orders often begin the Mass with the German Benedictus ("Gelobet sei der Herr, der Gott Israel"), sung by the schoolmaster, the children and all the people. It is sung without the organ, so that the people might learn the words of Scripture. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

> Int erste hefft an de scholemeister und singet dat düdesche Benedictus mit synen kindern und mit dem ganzen volke. […] Sülck Benedictus schal men nicht spelen up den orgelen, dat sick dat volk gewenne tho den worden der hilgen schrift. Darup singet men einen düdeschen psalm edder led uth der hilgen schrift gemaket, als im sankbökeschen doctoris Lutheri is.

First the schoolmaster beginneth, and singeth the German Benedictus with his children and with all the people. […] Such Benedictus shall not be played upon the organs, that the people may accustom themselves to the words of Holy Scripture. Thereupon a German psalm is sung, or a song made out of Holy Scripture, as is in Doctor Luther's little songbook.

**Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, pp. 340–341):

> De scholmeister eder cantor hevet balde an dat düdesch benedictus, den sank Sacharie, mit der differentia septimi toni, mit der antiph. alleine in fine, Gelavet si de herr de godt Israel […] Dar up singet me einen düdeschen psalm Erbarm di miner etc. eder einen anderen.

The schoolmaster or cantor straightway beginneth the German Benedictus, the song of Zacharias, with the *differentia* of the seventh tone, with the antiphon only at the end, "Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel" […]. Thereupon is sung a German psalm, "Have mercy on me," etc., or another. (Where there were good schools, a Latin introit might be sung at times.)

In Transylvania the German Benedictus replaced the Sunday procession that had been abolished; at Easter *Salve festa dies* was kept. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547**, Latin text (Sehling 24, p. 223):

> Dominicis diebus pro abrogato circuitu, ante Introitum, canitur Germanicum canticum Zachariae: Benedictus Dominus […] tempore Paschali: Salve festa dies.

On the Lord's days, for the procession that is abolished, before the introit is sung the German canticle of Zacharias, *Benedictus Dominus* […]; in Eastertide, *Salve festa dies*.

The German text of the same order (Sehling 24, p. 244):

> Am sontag an stat des abgelegten umbgangs singt man den lobgesang Zacharie: Gelobet sey der Herr. Zu Ostern: das Salve festa dies.

On the Sunday, in the stead of the procession laid aside, the song of praise of Zacharias is sung, "Blessed be the Lord." At Easter, the *Salve festa dies*.

The Wittenberg order of 1533 puts the Benedictus before everything, then an introit, Latin or a German psalm. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> Vor allem in der messen soll man erstlich singen das deutsch benedictus Sacharie mit seiner kurzen antiphon, darnach einen introitum, zu zeiten lateinisch, zu zeiten deutsch, welches soll sein ein deutscher psalm.

Before all things in the Mass there shall be sung first the German Benedictus of Zacharias with its short antiphon, thereafter an introit, at times in Latin, at times in German, which shall be a German psalm.

In the Henneberg village of Sulzfeld the Benedictus was sung "an stat des introitus". **Sulzfeld (Henneberg), 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 352):

> an stat des introitus hebt der schulmeister mit den knaben zu singen das benedictus Zachariae deutsch und darauf die antiphon: Gelobet sei der herre der gott Israel, wie es die noten ausweisen.

In the stead of the introit the schoolmaster with the boys beginneth to sing the Benedictus of Zacharias in German, and thereupon the antiphon "Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel," as the notes show.

#### 8.4.4 The German Te Deum at the opening

In some later northern orders the German Te Deum ("Herr Gott, dich loben wir") opens the morning service. It was played on the organ, or sung verse by verse. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1148):

> und da orgeln sein, sol der organist anfahen zu schlagen Herr Gott, wir loben dich etc. Da aber keine orgel ist, sol man es singen. Und wenn das geendet, sol der pastor in seinem gewönlichen langen rock für den altar treten, das meßkleid anziehen und den introitum de tempore singen. Darauf schlegt der organist das Kyrie, und der chor singet: Christe el[eison].

And where there are organs, the organist shall begin to play "Lord God, we praise thee," etc. But where there is no organ, it shall be sung. And when that is ended, the pastor in his accustomed long gown shall step before the altar, put on the Mass vestment, and sing the introit of the season. Thereupon the organist playeth the Kyrie, and the choir singeth *Christe eleison*.

The East Frisian order of Marienhafe, which follows Hoya, begins with a German Kyrie sung kneeling, "Ach Vatter", and then the Te Deum. **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 695):

> Zur hoichpredigt soll der schulmeister mit den knaben balt umme acht uhr dasein und kniend myt den Kyrie, Ach Vatter, ahnfangen etc. […] Darauf soll der organist das Te Deum laudamus anheben und das chor sampt der gemeinten dasselbe deutsch versch umb versch nach dem orgel andechtich singen etc. […] Darnach noch ein psalm oder geistlich leid, von prediger angesagt, spielen und singen.

For the high sermon the schoolmaster with the boys shall be there at eight o'clock, and begin kneeling with the Kyrie "Ah Father," etc. […] Thereupon the organist shall begin the *Te Deum laudamus*, and the choir together with the congregation shall sing the same in German devoutly, verse by verse, after the organ, etc. […] Thereafter yet a psalm or spiritual song, given out by the preacher, [shall be] played and sung.

The Hildesheim chapter lands opened with a choice of three: the German Te Deum, "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" or "Nun freut euch", followed by "Allein Gott". **Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 781):

> erstlich das deutsche Te Deum laudamus oder: Gott der Vater wahn uns bey und lasse uns etc oder: Nun freuwet euch lieben Christen gemain singen, darauf: Allein Gott in der höge sey ehr.

[He shall] first sing the German *Te Deum laudamus*, or "God the Father be with us, and let us," etc., or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all"; thereupon "To God alone on high be glory."

Where a village pastor could not sing matins with his sexton, Pomerania had the German Te Deum sung "pro introitu". **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 440):

> Wo de pastor mit dem cöstere nicht kan metten singen, alse vörhen gesecht is, schal he doch pro introitu singen dat düdische te deum laudamus, mit einer collecte.

Where the pastor cannot sing matins with the sexton, as is before said, he shall yet sing for the introit the German *Te Deum laudamus*, with a collect.

#### 8.4.5 A penitential psalm-hymn for the confession

In Hesse (Moderate Reformed) the congregation could sing Psalm 51 in Erhart Hegenwalt's metrical version ("Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott") in place of the spoken confession and absolution. **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 248):

> Darnach tut man entweder die bekantnis der sünden mit aufnemung der absolution, oder singt die ganze kirch den 51. psalm: Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott, etc.

Thereafter either the confession of sins is made, with the receiving of the absolution, or the whole church singeth the fifty-first psalm, "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.

Wittgenstein used "Aus tiefer Not" in the same way. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung* [1565]** (Sehling 22, p. 116):

> unnd nach dem Auß tieffer nott schrey ich zu dir etc. als ein confessionem singen unnd nach diesem das 6. capitel Johannis oder das 53. capitel Jesaiae vorlesen und alßdann den glauben singen, und folgend auff die cantzel tretten.

and thereafter sing "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., as a confession, and after this read the sixth chapter of John or the fifty-third chapter of Isaiah, and then sing the creed, and following that step up into the pulpit.

#### 8.4.6 A hymn to cover the priest's prayers at the altar step

In the Bugenhagen city order of Hildesheim the opening German psalm is sung while the priest kneels at the altar with the sexton and prays the preparatory prayers. **Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

> Int erste mach me singen vor dem introitum einen düdeschen psalm edder ledt, ut der hilligen schrift gemaket. Under dem gesange geit de prester vor dat altar unde kneet sick mit dem oppermanne, bedet vor sick unde vor dat volk unde vor alle nodt der christenheit.

First one may sing before the introit a German psalm or song made out of Holy Scripture. During the song the priest goeth before the altar and kneeleth with the sexton, and prayeth for himself and for the people and for all the need of Christendom.

#### 8.4.7 How fixed the opening was

The opening slot was the most stable in the corpus. Where a choice is named it is nearly always among these few:

- *Veni sancte Spiritus* (Latin antiphon), or its German forms "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" (Luther's hymn) and "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle" (prose, sung to the Latin melody).
- "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist".
- The German Benedictus.
- The German Te Deum.
- Psalm 51 ("Erbarm dich mein" or "O Herre Gott, begnade mich").

Only the grading by feast varies (§8.4.1). A few orders instead fill the slot with a seasonal song "pro ingressu" at vespers (§8.16.2).

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### 8.5 Hymns in place of the introit

The introit is a proper, and this chapter does not treat the Latin introits as such. But it is the proper most often replaced by a hymn. The rule is nearly everywhere the same. A Latin introit taken from Scripture might be kept where a school could sing it. Otherwise, and in the villages always, "a German psalm" was sung instead. In the 16th century a "German psalm" (*ein deutscher Psalm*) is any metrical hymn, above all Luther's psalm-hymns, and not only a paraphrase of a psalm.

#### 8.5.1 The rule: a Scriptural introit, or a German psalm

**Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 89):

> Thom Ersten mach men singen effte lesen den Introitum, de nicht wedder de Gödtlike schrifft sy, men de gelick syn den yennen, de up den Sondagen, ock yn den Festen Christi, uth dem Psalter genamen, gesungen werden. Up den dörpen mach men einen düdeschen Psalmen vor den Introitum singen.

First one may sing or read the introit, such as is not against the divine Scripture, but like unto those which are sung on the Sundays, and also on the feasts of Christ, taken out of the Psalter. In the villages one may sing a German psalm for the introit.

**Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

> So der introitus in der misse hilliger schrift enlich, schall he ahn den festen edder fyrdagen beholden werden. So averst der introitus in der schrift ungegrundet edder sunst tor beteringe undenstlick were, schall ahnstede des introitus ein dudesch psalm gesungen werden, alse Kum, hilliger Geist, edder sunst ein ander na bevehl des pastoris. Des werkeldages averst schall stedewech vor den introitum ein dudesch psalm gesungen werden.

If the introit in the Mass be like unto Holy Scripture, it shall be kept on the feasts or holy days. But if the introit be not grounded in Scripture, or otherwise unserviceable to edification, then in the stead of the introit a German psalm shall be sung, as "Come,

Holy Ghost," or else another at the bidding of the pastor. But on the working day a German psalm shall always be sung for the introit.

**Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32). The German psalms already sung in place of the introit may stay until the new Latin schools can sing the Latin again:

> wo aber die introit abgethan sein, und deütsch psalmen dafur gesungen werden, lass man es auch dabei bleiben, bis das man der aufgerichten lateinischen schulen halben den lateinischen introit oder ganzen lateinischen psalm an die stadt ordnen wirt.

but where the introits are done away and German psalms sung for them, let it also abide so, until, for the sake of the Latin schools set up, the Latin introit or the whole Latin psalm shall be ordained in their stead.

**Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 15). The reason for keeping some Latin is that "the tongues should not be put so wholly out of the church's use":

> möchte man die sonteglichen introit um ubung willen der jugent (so sie nu in der schulen wird zugenommen haben) lateinisch singen, oder an stadt des introitus einen psalmen deudsch oder lateinisch, als nemlich diesen, es wolt uns gott gnedig sein etc. oder einen andern denn ie die sprachen nicht sollen so ganz aus der kirchen übung gethan werden.

one might sing the Sunday introits in Latin for the exercise of the youth (when it shall now have increased in the school), or in the stead of the introit a psalm in German or Latin, namely this, "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or another; for the tongues should not be so wholly put out of the church's use.

**Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 243):

> In stede des introitus sall man singen einen duischen psalm Davids of dergelichen, mit Gades worde beweirt, darneist dat Kyrie eleison und Gloria in excelsis duisch.

In the stead of the introit shall be sung a German psalm of David, or the like, proved by God's word; next thereto the Kyrie eleison and *Gloria in excelsis* in German.

The Calenberg order replaces all four chants of the village Mass with a single psalm. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 795):

> Demnach sollen die pfarherrn anstat des introitus, des Et in terra, des haleluja und des sequenz als einen psalmen singen.

Accordingly the pastors shall sing, in the stead of the introit, the *Et in terra*, the alleluia and the sequence, a psalm for each.

The same rule reached the Bohemian villages of Teschen. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 462):

> Auf den dörfern aber mag man sonst einen gesang oder psalmen siengen anstadt des introits, deutsch oder böhemisch.

But in the villages one may otherwise sing a song or psalm in the stead of the introit, in German or Bohemian.

In the Albertine order the whole communion service of the villages begins with a hymn "pro introitu". **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 272):

> Wenn man communicanten hat, sol man das volk ein feinen psalm oder sonst ein geistlichen gesang lassen singen, pro introitu.

When there are communicants, the people shall be made to sing a fine psalm or else a spiritual song, for the introit.

#### 8.5.2 Which hymns: a short rotating list

Where the orders name the hymns for this slot, they give a short list, and several say plainly that the list is to be rotated. The favourites are Luther's and his circle's penitential and psalm-hymns: "Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein" (Ps 67), "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott" (Ps 51), "Aus tiefer Not" (Ps 130), "Ach Gott vom Himmel sieh darein" (Ps 12), "Wär Gott nicht mit uns" (Ps 124), "Es spricht der Unweisen Mund" (Ps 14), and "Komm heiliger Geist, Herre Gott".

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 64):

> Zum anfang, an stadt des introits, singt man der deüdschen psalmen einen, wie auch bishere alhie im fürstenthumb geschehen ist, nemlich: Es wolt uns got gnedig sein. Erbarm dich mein, o herre got. Aus tiefer noth. Ach gott vom himel sich darein. Wer got nicht mit uns diese zeit. Es spricht der unweisen mund wol etc. und dergleichen psalmen, umb einander abzuwechseln. In festen aber als Ostern, Pfingsten, Weinachten singe man die eigene introit deütsch oder lateinisch nach gelegenheit des orts, umb ubung willen, der jugend.

At the beginning, in the stead of the introit, one of the German psalms is sung, as hath been done hitherto here in the duchy, namely: "May God be gracious unto us"; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God"; "Out of the depths"; "Ah God, from heaven look down"; "Were God not with us at this time"; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," etc., and the like psalms, to be changed about one after another. But on feasts, as Easter, Pentecost, Christmas, let the proper introits be sung, in German or Latin according to the occasion of the place, for the exercise of the youth.

**Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71) alternates three hymns Sunday by Sunday, and keeps sung Latin introits in part-music for the feasts:

> Für den introitum singet man einen sontag umb den andern: Kom heiliger geist etc. Erbarm dich mein etc. Aus tiefer noth etc. An den hohen festen aber singt man in mensuris als zu Weinachten. Den introitum puer natus oder dies est laetitiae etc. Palmarum. Gloria, laus et honor. Ostern. Salve festa dies etc. Pfingsten. Introitum de sancto spiritu. Trinitatis. Introitum de trinitate. Annunciationis Mariae. Haec est dies etc.

For the introit is sung, one Sunday after another: "Come, Holy Ghost," etc.; "Have mercy on me," etc.; "Out of the depths," etc. But on the high feasts one singeth in measured music, as at Christmas the introit *Puer natus*, or *Dies est laetitiae*, etc.; Palm Sunday, *Gloria, laus et honor*; Easter, *Salve festa dies*, etc.; Pentecost, the introit of the Holy Ghost; Trinity, the introit of the Trinity; the Annunciation of Mary, *Haec est dies*, etc.

The St George's order of Nördlingen (1555) copies this rotation, putting it after the Latin introit and before the confession (Sehling 12, p. 319). The *Auctuarium* of Brandenburg-Ansbach, an Interim order, gives the fullest village list. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, pp. 329–330):

> Wo nit schulen oder leut vorhanden, die lateinisch singen konten, sollen die pfarhern anstad des introitus mit dem volk singen: Nun freud euch, lieben Christen gemain etc. Dis sind die heiligen zehen gebot etc. Erbarm, dich mein, o Herr Gott etc, […] Ich ruef zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ etc.

Where there are no schools, or folk that could sing Latin, the pastors shall sing with the people in the stead of the introit: "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc.; "These are the holy ten commandments," etc.; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.; […] "I call to thee, Lord Jesu Christ," etc.

In the Pomeranian orders of 1542 and 1569 the choice is Latin introit or Psalm 51, in one of its two German versions. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> heven den introitum an to latin, efft singen einen düdeschen psalm darvor, erbarm di miner, in der melodie als idt in den druckeden sankbokern steit, efft den psalm, o here godt begnade mi etc.

[they] begin the introit in Latin, or sing a German psalm for it, "Have mercy on me," in the melody as it standeth in the printed songbooks, or the psalm "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc.

**Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 437):

> Tom anfange singet dat chor den introitum de festo vel tempore, edder up de dominica, edder: Kum hilige geist, herre godt. Erbarme di miner. O herre godt begnade mi etc. edder einen andern düdeschen psalm.

At the beginning the choir singeth the introit of the feast or of the season, or of the Sunday; or "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God"; "Have mercy on me"; "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc.; or another German psalm.

#### 8.5.3 Early German Masses: a hymn as the introit itself

In some of the earliest German Masses a hymn stands where the introit stood, under the heading *Introitus*. The Nürnberg hospital Mass of Andreas Döber prints "Nun bitten wir" with the heading "Introitus oder eingang der meß". **Nürnberg, Döber's**

**German Mass in the New Hospital, 1525** (Sehling 11, p. 56):

> Introitus oder eingang der meß. [Noten] Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist [4 Verse. Hier nicht abgedruckt; dann Schluß der Noten].

Introit, or entrance of the Mass. [Notes] "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" [four verses].

Strasbourg's Mass of 1525 (Moderate Reformed) had Psalm 51 or Psalm 130 "an stat des Introits". **Strasbourg, *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 156):

> Auff das fahet an die kirch zu singen ein psalmen als das Miserere oder ein anderen psalmen an stat des Introits und etwan das Kyrieleyson und Gloria in excelsis. Der CXXX. Psalm: De profundis, an stat des Introits etwan in der Meß: Uß tieffer not schrey ich zu dir.

Thereupon the church beginneth to sing a psalm, as the Miserere or another psalm, in the stead of the introit, and sometimes the Kyrie eleison and *Gloria in excelsis*. The hundred and thirtieth psalm, *De profundis*, sometimes in the stead of the introit in the Mass: "Out of the depths I cry to thee."

A Low German Mass from Lippe gives "Uth deper nodt" as the introit, with the choice of any other psalm. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 565):

> Dewyle averst de prester den confiteor lest, synget dat choer den introitum der misse. Introitus misse Uth deper nodt schrye ik tho dy etc. Offte eynen anderen psalmen, wat me vor eynen wyl. Item, nu thor tydt synget dat choer offte volck ghemeylick vor dem introitu de antiffen Veni sancte spiritus, Kum, hillige geist.

But while the priest readeth the *Confiteor*, the choir singeth the introit of the Mass. Introit of the Mass: "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., or another psalm, whichever one will. Item, now at this time the choir or people commonly sing before the introit the antiphon *Veni sancte Spiritus*, "Come, Holy Ghost."

#### 8.5.4 A hymn of the feast for the introit

On feasts, some orders let a hymn of the feast replace the Latin festal introit. Mecklenburg sang Luther's Christmas *Leise* "Ein Kindelein so löbelich" (the four stanzas of "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich") at Candlemas and on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

> In die Purificationis singe me vor enen introitum de veer schonen versche. Ein kindelin etc. Welck ock de sondage twischen winachten und lechtmissen up den dörpern schal vor enen introitum gesungen werden. Up welckere sondage in den steden, under tiden dat Offitium, Puer natus, mach gesungen werden.

On the day of the Purification let the four fair verses, "A little Child," etc., be sung for an introit. The same shall also be sung for an introit in the villages on the Sundays between Christmas and Candlemas; on which Sundays in the towns the office *Puer natus* may be sung at times.

Wittgenstein kept the Latin introits of the high feasts but allowed three hymns in their place: "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich" for *Puer natus*, "Christ lag in Todesbanden" for *Resurrexi*, and "Es ist das Heil" for *Spiritus Domini*. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

> nach dem Veni sancte den gewönlichen introitum singen, als da sind: Puer natus est nobis etc., Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum etc., Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum etc., welche man auch auff den dörffern deutsch lernen und singen kan oder an stadt derselbigen brauchen: Der tag, der ist so freudenreich etc., Christ lag in todes banden etc., Es ist das heyl uns kommen her etc.

[they shall] after the *Veni sancte* sing the customary introit, as these are: *Puer natus est nobis*, etc., *Resurrexi et adhuc tecum sum*, etc., *Spiritus Domini replevit orbem terrarum*, etc.; which may also be learned and sung in German in the villages, or, in the stead of the same, may be used: "The day that is so full of joy," etc., "Christ lay in the bands of death," etc., "Salvation now is come to us," etc.

In the Henneberg village of Sulzfeld the chorus sang the Christmas song "Ein Kind geboren zu Bethlehem" (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*) instead of the introit, and "Also heilig ist der Tag" three times at Easter and Ascension. **Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf,**

***Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 353):

> zu weinachten an stat des introitus singt der chor: Ein kind geboren zu Bethlehem, auf ostern und himmelfart aber: Also heilig ist der tag etc. dreimal und an stat des psalmen zwischen den capiteln werden die gewönlich lieder von festen gesungen.

At Christmas, in the stead of the introit, the choir singeth "A Child is born in Bethlehem"; but at Easter and the Ascension, "So holy is the day," etc., three times; and in the stead of the psalm between the chapters the customary songs of the feasts are sung.

The Hamburg order of 1529 lists the Latin introits for the feasts it keeps. For other feasts, where there is no chant from Scripture, it allows "joyful psalms and songs". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

> Int erste singet me einen dudeschen psalm, edder up etlike feste latinisch. Van winachten bet up purificationis puer natus. Twischen paschen und der hemmelfart salus populi ego sum. Darna bet up pinxten viri galilei. Van pinxten spiritus domini. Van sunte Johanse ne timeas Sacharia […] Van sunte Michael Benedicite domino. Up feste, dar men sundergen sank ut der schrift nicht van hefft, kan me wol frolike psalme und lede singen.

First is sung a German psalm, or on certain feasts [an introit] in Latin: from Christmas unto the Purification, *Puer natus*; between Easter and the Ascension, *Salus populi ego sum*; thereafter unto Pentecost, *Viri Galilaei*; from Pentecost, *Spiritus Domini*; of St John, *Ne timeas, Zacharia* […]; of St Michael, *Benedicite Domino*. On feasts whereof one hath no proper chant out of Scripture, one may well sing joyful psalms and songs.

#### 8.5.5 A German prose antiphon as introit

Ritzebüttel, in Hamburg's territory, sang the prose German "Komm, heiliger Geist, erfülle" with its Alleluia "in stede des introitus". **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

> Des sondages anfenglick hevet men an, in stede des introitus to singen den dudeschen gesanck: Kum hilliger geist, erfülle die herten diener gelovigen, und entfenge in en dat fuer diner godtlicken leer […] Alleluia.

On the Sunday one beginneth first to sing, in the stead of the introit, the German song "Come, Holy Ghost, fill the hearts of thy faithful, and kindle in them the fire of thy divine love" […] Alleluia.

#### 8.5.6 Why a short list: that the people might learn them

The Halle order explains the aim of the rotation. The German psalms sung "pro introitu" were to be chosen so that the whole church might become sure of some good psalms, and in time of the whole Psalter, as at Jena. **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein*, 1543** (Sehling 2, p. 436):

> Wan man Aus tiefer noth, oder andere deutsche psalmen pro introitu singet, sollen dieselbigen dahin gericht werden, das die ganze kirche etlicher gueter trostlicher nüzlicher psalmen gewiss gewone, und man kente mit der zeit anrichten, das aller psalmen im ganzen psalter das volk durch solche fleissige übung, wan man der psalmen nacheinander brauchet, gewenete, wie in etlichen kirchen, als zu Jena und andern orten nüzlich angericht.

When "Out of the depths" or other German psalms are sung for the introit, the same shall be so ordered that the whole church may become surely accustomed to some good, comfortable, profitable psalms; and in time it might be brought about that the people, by such diligent exercise, using the psalms one after another, should grow accustomed to all the psalms in the whole Psalter, as hath been profitably set up in some churches, as at Jena and other places.

Nördlingen dropped the introit altogether when the psalm after the epistle was a long one, and in winter "for the cold and for beloved brevity's sake". **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 375):

> Wo aber ein langer psalm fürfelle als Vater unser, Nun freuet euch, lieben christen gemein, Es ist das heil uns kommen her, Durch Adams fall, Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns helt und dergleichen, so würd der introitus zu singen ausgelassen und schlegt allein der organist. Sonderlich aber zue winterszeiten solle der introitus umb der kelte und geliebter kurze wülen ausgelassen werden.

But where a long psalm falleth, as "Our Father," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," "Salvation now is come to us," "Through Adam's fall," "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," and the like, then the singing of the introit is left out, and the organist alone playeth. But especially in the winter season the introit shall be left out, for the cold's sake and for beloved brevity's sake.

#### 8.5.7 How fixed the slot was

Where a German hymn replaced the introit, the choice was among **a handful**, usually rotated. The core was "Komm heiliger Geist", Psalm 51, Psalm 130 and Psalm 67, with a few other psalm-hymns. At the high feasts the Latin introit returned, or a hymn of the feast took its place. No order found assigns a different introit-hymn to each Sunday of the year, as the Latin propers had done.

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## 8.6 The Kyrie: plain, in three tongues, troped and German

The Kyrie is an ordinary, not a proper, so it was not replaced by a hymn in the way the introit was. But it was sung in German, it was troped in German, and it was graded by season, like the medieval Kyrie melodies. Most orders cut it back to three petitions, one to each Person of the Trinity. The Kyrie melodies of the chant books (*summum*, *paschale*, *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *in adventu*, *de beata Virgine*) survived as seasonal grades in the Lutheran cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius. The grades themselves are treated in Chapter 12 §12.4.2. This section deals with the texts sung to them.

The Kyrie in the order of the Mass, and the seasonal Kyrie chants named in the orders, are treated in Chapter 2, §2.6.

#### 8.6.1 Three times, not nine

Luther's *Deutsche Messe* already prescribed the Kyrie "drei mal und nicht neun mal" (Sehling 1, p. 14). The Wolfenbüttel order gives the reason: once for each Person of the Trinity. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

> Id is nicht van nöden, negen mal dat eleison edder Kyrie tho repetirende, yd is genoch dremal im namen des Vaders und des Sons und des hilgen Geistes tho singende ane orgelen.

It is not needful to repeat the *eleison* or Kyrie nine times; it is enough to sing it three times, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, without organs.

Wittenberg kept a nine-fold Kyrie for the feasts. After the plain three-fold Kyrie there was no Gloria. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> Darnach das rechte kyrie dreimal, oder zu zeiten, besondern uf die feste, ein anders neunmal, wie gewonlich. Auf das schlechte kyrie singet man nicht gloria in excelsis deo, sondern auf andere, wenn man will, und sonderlich uf die feste.

Thereafter the right Kyrie three times; or at times, especially on the feasts, another nine times, as is customary. After the plain Kyrie one singeth not *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, but after the others, when one will, and especially on the feasts.

#### 8.6.2 In three tongues

Two Baltic orders have the three petitions sung in three languages: Greek, Latin and German. **Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Von dem kyrieleyson ist fur gut angesehen, dieweil es dreimal gesungen wirt, das es in dreien zungen, wie man auch alhier pfleget, krichisch, lateinisch und deütsch gefangen werde.

Of the Kyrie eleison it is thought good, since it is sung three times, that it be sung in three tongues, as is also the custom here: Greek, Latin and German.

**Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 15):

> Auf den introit, singt man das kyrie eleison, mit wenig noten (ausgenommen auf die hohen fest, da man notam paschalem nemen mag) und were nicht unformlich, das es in dreien zungen, kriechisch, lateinisch und deudsch, wie man auch an etlichen orten pfleget, gesungen würde, die weil es doch dreimal gesungen wird.

After the introit the Kyrie eleison is sung with few notes (save on the high feasts, when the Easter note may be taken). And it were not unseemly that it be sung in three tongues, Greek, Latin and German, as is the custom in some places, since it is sung three times.

#### 8.6.3 Bugenhagen's defence of the Greek Kyrie

Bugenhagen defended keeping the Greek words, even in German. The people already sang *Kyrieleis* at the end of their best-loved hymns. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 438):

> Eynen düdeschen text uth latinischer edder anderer hilger scrift to maken mit schicklikeme sange, is nicht eynes jederen mannes, unlustich singen anrichten is neyne kunst. Worumme scholde me dat Kyrie elsen in der misse nicht singen? Singet me id doch in anderen leden, alse synt: Got sy gelavet, Midden in deme levend, Dit synt de hilgen teyn gebot, Mynsche wiltu leven salichlick, Christ is upgestanden, Nu bidde wy den hilgen Geyst, Gelavet sistu Jesu Christ etc.

To make a German text out of Latin or other holy Scripture, with a seemly tune, is not every man's work; to set up an unlovely singing is no art. Why should one not sing the Kyrie eleison in the Mass? For it is sung in other songs, as are: "God be praised," "In the midst of life," "These are the holy ten commandments," "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," "Christ is arisen," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.

#### 8.6.4 Troped German Kyries

Several orders print German Kyries that expand each petition, as the medieval tropes did. They were sung to the melodies of the Latin troped Kyries of the same names.

The oldest is in a Low German manuscript Mass from Schleswig-Holstein, written after 1526. Its first Kyrie is troped; the *Kyrie dominicale* follows plain. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, p. 56):

> Here, o Godt vader yn ewicheit, de du levest unde aver alle regerst, vorbarme dy unser. Criste, de du heffst upgeloßet den bant des dodes, vorbarme dy unßer. Here, o hilge geist, de du van vader unde sone utgeist unde gelyck Godt gepryset werst, vorbarme dy unser. […] Kyrie Dominicale Here, Got vader, vorbarme dy unser. Criste, vorbar me dy unser. Here, hylige geist, vorbarme dy unser.

Lord, O God the Father in eternity, who livest and reignest over all, have mercy upon us. Christ, who hast loosed the band of death, have mercy upon us. Lord, O Holy Ghost, who proceedest from the Father and the Son and art praised as God alike, have mercy upon us. […] *Kyrie dominicale*: Lord God the Father, have mercy upon us. Christ, have mercy upon us. Lord, Holy Ghost, have mercy upon us.

The Naumburg order prints three German Kyries for the high Mass on feast days: the *summum* ("Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit"), the *paschale* ("O Herre Gott, Vater in Ewigkeit") and the *magne Deus* ("O Vater, allmächtiger Gott"). **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 78):

> Hierauf singt der ganze chor das kyrie eleison wie volget. Kyrie sumum. Kyrie got vater in ewigkeit, gross ist dein barmherzigkeit, aller ding ein schopfer und regirer eleison. Christe aller welt trost und sunder allein due hast erlost, o Jesu gottes sohn unser mitler bist in dem hochstem thron, zu dir schreien wir aus herzen begier eleison, kyrie got heiliger geist trost sterk uns im glauben alle zeit, das wir am letzten end frolich uns scheiden aus diesem elend, eleison. Kyrie paschale. O herre gott, vater in ewigkeit bis uns sundern gnedig, Christe der werlet heilant und ihr trost mach uns allen von sunden los. O gott heiliger geist, theil uns mit weisheit lieb und glauben allermeist, bring gotlich gerechtigkeit. Kyrie magne deus. O vater almechtiger gott zu dir schreien wir in der noth, durch dein gross barmherzigkeit erbarme dich uber uns. Christe wolst uns horen, fur uns bistue geboren von Maria, erbarm dich uber uns. Herr vorgib uns unser sunde, hilf uns in der letzten stunde, der due für uns bist gestorben, erbarme dich uber uns.

Hereupon the whole choir singeth the Kyrie eleison as followeth. *Kyrie summum*: "Kyrie, God the Father in eternity, great is thy mercy, Creator and Ruler of all things, *eleison*. Christ, comfort of all the world, thou alone hast redeemed sinners; O Jesu, Son of God, our mediator thou art in the highest throne; to thee we cry with the desire of our heart, *eleison*. Kyrie, God the Holy Ghost, comfort, strengthen us in faith at all times, that at the last end we may depart joyfully out of this misery, *eleison*." *Kyrie paschale*: "O Lord God, Father in eternity, be gracious unto us sinners. Christ, Saviour of the world and its comfort, make us all free from sins. O God the Holy Ghost, impart unto us wisdom, love, and faith most of all; bring divine righteousness." *Kyrie magne Deus*:

"O Father, almighty God, to thee we cry in our need; by thy great mercy have mercy upon us. Christ, be pleased to hear us, who for us wast born of Mary; have mercy upon us. Lord, forgive us our sins, help us in the last hour, thou who for us hast died; have mercy upon us."

The St George's order of Nördlingen (1555) takes over these three German Kyries by season: the *paschale* from Easter to Pentecost, the *Fons bonitatis* from Pentecost to Christmas, and the *Magne Deus* from Christmas to Easter (Sehling 12, p. 318).

The *summum* text, "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit", became the common German festal Kyrie. A Henneberg pastor calls it "das schöne christliche gesang". **Obermassfeld (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 343):

> singt der schulmeister mit den knaben und der kirchen, wan communicanten vorhanden sind, erstlich das schöne christliche gesang: Kyrie got vater in ewigkeit, gros ist deine barmherzigkeit etc. Folgend darauf das Gloria in excelsis deo wie dasselbige auch gesangsweis deutsch gestellet: Allein got in der höhe sei ehr und dank für seine gnade etc. Wo aber nicht communicanten vorhanden singen wir: Kom heiliger geist, herre got.

When communicants are present, the schoolmaster with the boys and the church singeth first the fair Christian song "Kyrie, God the Father in eternity, great is thy mercy," etc. Following thereupon, the *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, as the same is also set in German as a song: "To God alone on high be glory and thanks for his grace," etc. But where no communicants are present we sing "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God."

Hof names the German Kyries by the Latin melodies they were sung to. At Christmas (Sehling 11, p. 433):

> Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae: O Vater allmechtiger Gott.

*Kyrie magnae Deus potentiae*: "O Father, almighty God."

At Pentecost (Sehling 11, p. 441):

> Kyrie fons bonitatis: [Noten] Kyrie, Gott Vater in ewigkeit [Ende der Noten]. Loco Et in terra: All ehr und lob soll Gottes sein.

*Kyrie fons bonitatis*: [notes] "Kyrie, God the Father in eternity" [end of notes]. In the place of *Et in terra*: "All honour and praise shall be God's."

The Mecklenburg order of 1545 has the German *Kyrie summum* "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott" sung in the villages, where the sexton was to teach it to the people. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

> Das düdesche kyrie summum: Ach vader, alder högeste godt, schölen de kerckheren up den dörpern singen, unde dem volke idt leren, dat de ganze kercke idt singe. De koster kan groth gut darinne don, wenn he sick nicht ut dem wege stickt, ock nicht (wo etlike don) up dat altar liggen gaen, sonder im chör sick to tiden na der kercken wende, und dem volke wol vorsinge. Dat kyrie paschale, kyrie angelicum, dominicale, de anderen to tiden ock mach men in den steden singen.

The German *Kyrie summum*, "Ah Father, God most high," the parsons shall sing in the villages, and teach it to the people, that the whole church may sing it. The sexton can do great good herein, if he keep not out of the way, nor (as some do) go and lie upon the altar, but turn himself at times in the choir toward the church and sing it well before the people. The *Kyrie paschale*, *Kyrie angelicum*, *dominicale* and the others may also at times be sung in the towns.

"Ach Vater" was still the opening Kyrie at Marienhafe in 1593, sung kneeling (§8.4.4). The Ritzebüttel order gives three German Kyries, one plain and two troped, "each with its own melody". **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 557):

> Darna wert gesungen dat kyrieleison mit noten in dudescher sprake also: Herr godt vader, erbarme di unser. Christe, godt sohn, erbarme di unser. Herr godt, heiliger geist, erbarme di unser. Ein andrer kyrieleison. Also: Herr godt vader, alder hogste godt, wie klein achtet man din gebot. Verschone unser blindheit, die vele sunde deit. Erbarme di unser Christe, der du bist die weg und dat ware licht. Die porte der warheit, und dat levent, des vaters radt und wort, den he uns hefft tom troste gegeven, erbarm die unser. Herr, hillige geist in ewicheit, stah uns bi dorch dine barmhertigkeit; unse sunde sind uns leid, wil nicht vorlaten di in di hapen, erbarm di unser. Ein ander kyrie. Also: Kyrie, milde vader, wie bidden di alle, vader, erbarme di unser. Christe, unse konink und herr, erbarm di unser. Kyrie, heiliger geist, die du ein troster der bloden bist, erbarme di unser. Ein ieder mit siner melodie.

Thereafter the Kyrie eleison is sung with notes in the German tongue thus: "Lord God the Father, have mercy upon us. Christ, God the Son, have mercy upon us. Lord God, Holy Ghost, have mercy upon us." Another Kyrie eleison, thus: "Lord God the Father, God most high, how little is thy commandment regarded! Spare our blindness, which doeth many sins; have mercy upon us. Christ, who art the way and the true light, the gate of truth and the life, the Father's counsel and word, whom he hath given us for our comfort, have mercy upon us. Lord, Holy Ghost in eternity, stand by us through thy mercy; our sins are grievous unto us; we will not forsake thee, in thee we hope; have mercy upon us." Another Kyrie, thus: "Kyrie, gentle Father, we all pray thee, Father, have mercy upon us. Christ, our King and Lord, have mercy upon us. Kyrie, Holy Ghost, who art the comforter of the fainthearted, have mercy upon us." Each with its own melody.

The Ritzebüttel order also speaks of a *missa dominicalis*, *paschalis*, *pentecostes* and *nativitatis*: seasonal sets of Kyrie and Gloria. The songbook appended to the Pfalz-Zweibrücken *Kirchenordnung* of 1557 prints three German Kyries, each paired with a German Gloria. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, songbook (Sehling 18, p. 248):

> Folget das Kyrieleison mit dem Gloria in Excelsis: Kyrie Eleyson, Herr erbarme dich. Gloria in Excelsis: Glori sey Gott in der höhe Und auff erden Frid. Ein ander Kyrie und Et in terra: Herr, erbarm dich unser. Ehre sei Gott in der höhe. Kyrie Paschale: Kyrie, Gott aller welt sehöpffer und Vatter, Eleyson. Gloria in Exelsis Deo: All ehr und lob sol Gottes sein.

Here followeth the Kyrie eleison with the *Gloria in excelsis*: "Kyrie eleison, Lord have mercy." *Gloria in excelsis*: "Glory be to God on high, and on earth peace." Another Kyrie and *Et in terra*: "Lord, have mercy upon us." "Glory be to God on high." *Kyrie paschale*: "Kyrie, God, Creator of all the world, and Father, *eleison*." *Gloria in excelsis Deo*: "All honour and praise shall be God's."

The Henneberg village orders also name the German *Kyrie summum*, sung after the German Benedictus "or [the Kyrie] of the present feast". **Herpf (Henneberg), 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 334):

> So man communicanten hat, singt man das benedictus deutsch, darauf auch das deutsch kyrie eleison summum oder vom gegenwertigen fest.

When there are communicants, the Benedictus is sung in German, thereupon also the German *Kyrie eleison summum*, or that of the present feast.

At Wasungen the school, when there were no communicants, sang a long psalm-hymn with "three short Kyries in German" added at the end. **Wasungen (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 356):

> Anfenglich singet die schul die deutsche letanei oder sonsten einen zimlichen langen psalmen als das vater unser oder: Durch Adams fall oder mit den drei kurzen kyrie daran gehenget deutsch: O herre gott vater allen barmherzigkeit bist uns sündern gnedig etc.

At the beginning the school singeth the German litany, or else a fairly long psalm, as the Our Father or "Through Adam's fall," or, with the three short Kyries hung thereto in German, "O Lord God, Father of all mercy, be gracious unto us sinners," etc.

#### 8.6.5 The Kyrie and Gloria in one hymn: "Allein Gott"

In East Frisia the German Kyrie and Gloria together were sung "as it is sung in the song *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr*". **Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 7/1, p. 376):

> Tom ersten schal gesungen werden eyn edder twee duedsche psalmen. Darna synge man dat Kyrieleyson sampt den Gloria in excelsis to duedsche, alze dat gesungen wort in dem gesenge Alleyn Godt in der hoge sy eer.

First shall be sung one or two German psalms. Thereafter let the Kyrie eleison together with the *Gloria in excelsis* be sung in German, as it is sung in the song "To God alone on high be glory."

#### 8.6.6 How fixed the Kyrie was

The Kyrie was **fixed by grade**. Its text hardly changed. Its melody changed with the season and the rank of the day, where a school could sing the grades. In the villages there was one German Kyrie, or three at most, rotated by season. No order found fits the Kyrie to the gospel of the day. It is the most calendar-bound and least topical of the sung ordinaries.

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## 8.7 The Gloria: "Allein Gott in der Höh" and "All Ehr und Lob"

Two German Gloria hymns run through the orders:

- Nikolaus Decius's "Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr", which reached the north first in Low German ("Allene Gade in der hoge sy ere").
- Luther's rhymed *Et in terra*, "All Ehr und Lob soll Gottes sein".

The priest's Latin or German intonation ("Gloria in excelsis Deo", "Ehre sei Gott in der Höhe") usually stayed. The hymn was sung for, or together with, the choir's *Et in terra*.

The Gloria in the order of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.7.

### 8.7.1 The German hymn inside the Latin Gloria

The Bugenhagen orders of Wolfenbüttel (1543) and Hildesheim (1544) interpolate the whole of "Allein Gott" into the Latin Gloria. The priest intones. The school choir sings the first line of the Latin. The whole church sings "Allein Gott" through. Then the scholars and the organ go on with *Laudamus te* to the end. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 55):

> Na dem Kyrie singet de prester: Gloria in excelsis Deo. Dat scholerchor antwerdet und singet: Et in terra pax, hominibus bona voluntas, nicht mehr. Balde singet de ganze kercke: Alleine Got in der höged sy ehr etc. vul uth. Darna singen de scholer und orgeln vordan: Laudamus te, benedicimus te etc. vul uth.

After the Kyrie the priest singeth: *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. The scholars' choir answereth and singeth: *Et in terra pax, hominibus bona voluntas*, no more. Straightway the whole church singeth "To God alone on high be glory," etc., fully through. Thereafter the scholars and the organs sing on: *Laudamus te, benedicimus te*, etc., fully through.

The Hildesheim city order of 1544 has the same rubric almost word for word (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852). The Osnabrück city order puts "Allein Gott" straight after the intonation, and then the Latin Gloria "to the end". **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 258):

> Gloria in excelsis, darup gesungen Allene Gott in der höhe sy ehr, darna dat latineschen Gloria in excelsis, verfolget bet tom ende.

*Gloria in excelsis*; thereupon is sung "To God alone on high be glory"; thereafter the Latin *Gloria in excelsis*, followed through to the end.

### 8.7.2 Latin one Sunday, German the next

Where a school sang the Latin, many orders alternated it with the German hymn so that the people would not lose their part. The Prussian order says so outright. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

> Darauf singet der priester mit gebürlicher reverenz: Gloria in excelsis deo, der chor einen sonntag um den andern: Et in terra pax, oder: Allein gott in der höhe sei ehre, denn man muss die deutschen psalmen auch in ubung behalten und dem gemeinen haufen auch raum geben, das sie ihre andacht mit solchen geistlichen liedern uben.

Thereupon the priest singeth with due reverence *Gloria in excelsis Deo*; the choir, one Sunday after the other, *Et in terra pax*, or "To God alone on high be glory." For the German psalms must also be kept in use, and room be given to the common multitude also, that they may exercise their devotion with such spiritual songs.

**Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555**, for the convents (Sehling 6/1, p. 614):

> In der messe soll gesungen werden introitus, Kyrieleison, Gloria in excelsis et in terra pax oder Allein Gott in der hohe einen Sontag umb den anderen.

In the Mass shall be sung the introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis et in terra pax*, or "To God alone on high," one Sunday after the other.

At Harzgerode in Anhalt the Latin *Gloria* and *Et in terra dominicale* alternated with the German on ordinary Sundays. At Christmas the old verses *Dies est laetitiae* were sung into it in Latin and German. **Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

> Volgende das Kyrie eleison auf die grosse feste mit dem Gloria in excelsis und Et in terra auf der orgel und chor, und zu weinachten mag man nach alten gebrauchen die vers dies est laeticie cum sequentibus latine und deutsch mit dreinsingen. Aber an die gemein sontag sol man umb einander einen sontag das latinsche gloria und Et in terra dominicale, den a[ndern] […].

Following, the Kyrie eleison on the great feasts, with the *Gloria in excelsis* and *Et in terra*, upon the organ and by the choir; and at Christmas one may, after old custom, sing in among them the verses *Dies est laetitiae* with those following, in Latin and German. But on the common Sundays one shall sing by turns, one Sunday the Latin *Gloria* and the *Et in terra dominicale*, the other [the German] […].

Pomerania allowed the laity "Allein Gott" after the choir's *Et in terra*. When that grew too long, one or other was dropped by turns, and in Lent the Gloria might be left out altogether. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> die chor singe darup dat et in terra, wenn dat ut is, lat me die leien singen, allein godt in der hoge si ehr; wenn idt will to lange werden, so lat me under tiden dat latinische, unter tiden dat düdesche na, in der vasten mach me dat gloria wol gar ute laten.

The choir singeth thereupon the *Et in terra*; when that is out, let the laity sing "To God alone on high be glory." When it will grow too long, let the Latin be left off at times, and the German at times; in Lent the Gloria may well be left out altogether.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* of 1569 offers both German Glorias. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 437):

> Et in terra pax, latin edder düdisch: Allene godt in der högede si ehre etc., Alle ehre unde pris schal gades sin, etc.

*Et in terra pax*, in Latin or German: "To God alone on high be glory," etc., "All honour and praise shall be God's," etc.

#### 8.7.3 Teaching the people to sing it

Oldenburg placed the sexton and some scholars among the congregation, below the choir. There they sang the German *Et in terra* and other German hymns in alternation with the upper choir, so that the people might learn tune and words. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1089):

> lateinisch für sich selbst, zu zeiten deudsch mit dem volk oder auch umbgewechselt singen. Darzu denn vonnöten, das der opperman oder küster sampt etlichen schülern an einem gewissen ort bey der gemein unter dem chor stehet und das deudsche Et in terra, wie auch andere deudsche geistliche heder mit umbwechselung der vers und gesetz des öbern chors singen, damit das volk des gesangs der melodey und der wörter je lenger je mehr gewohne und lust und liebe darzu gewinne.

[the scholars shall sing the *Et in terra pax*, at times] in Latin by themselves, at times in German with the people, or else by turns. For which it is needful that the sexton or clerk, with some scholars, stand at a set place by the congregation beneath the choir, and sing the German *Et in terra*, as also other German spiritual songs, changing verses and stanzas with the upper choir, that the people may more and more grow used to the song, the melody and the words, and win pleasure and love thereto.

The Brenz order for Schwäbisch Hall had hoped for this from the start. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 49):

> Nach dem Kirieleyson dient wol das lobgesang Gottes, Gloria in excelsis, nach gelegenhait der zeyt und alter gewonhait, were auch gut zubesserung der kirchen, wie alle ding geschehen sollen in der gemein versamlung, das mit der Zeyt das volck uff teutsch das lobgesang, von engeln gesungen, et in terra pax hominibus und psalmen singen lernt.

After the Kyrie eleison the song of praise to God, *Gloria in excelsis*, serveth well, according to the occasion of the season and the old custom. It were also good for the edifying of the church, as all things should be done in the common assembly, that the people should in time learn to sing in German the song of praise sung by the angels, *et in terra pax hominibus*, and psalms.

Bugenhagen asked for "fine short German notes" for a German Gloria, so that children, maids and women could sing it together. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 438–439):

> Wil me övers Gloria in excelsis düdesch underwilen singen, besundergen dar neyne schölere synt, so schicke me ock fine korte düdesche noten darto, dat kyndere, megede unde wyve […] konen schicklick unde eyntrechtichlick mitsingen unde

> nicht alleyne de, de des latinischen sanges gewanet synt.

But if one will at times sing the *Gloria in excelsis* in German, especially where there are no scholars, let fine short German notes also be provided for it, that children, maids and wives […] may sing along seemly and with one accord, and not only those that are used to the Latin singing.

An early Low German Mass from Lippe prints "Allene Gade in der hoge" as the Gloria then "commonly" sung. **Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 566):

> ghemeynlick synget me nu düt nabescreven Gloria in excelsis […] Gloria in excelsis Deo Allene Gade in der hoge sy ere unde danck vor syne gnade.

Commonly this Gloria in excelsis written hereafter is now sung […]. *Gloria in excelsis Deo*: "To God alone on high be glory and thanks for his grace."

#### 8.7.4 Intonation and answer

In Wittgenstein the priest intoned in German and the people answered with Decius's hymn. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 102):

> Preiß sey Gott in der höhe. Antwortet der chor oder das volck: Allein Gott in der hohe sey ehr und danck vor seine gnade etc.

"Praise be to God on high." The choir or the people answereth: "To God alone on high be glory and thanks for his grace," etc.

Luther's "All Ehr und Lob" was the other answer. In Nördlingen two choirs sang it stanza by stanza until the organ was ready. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 312):

> und die zwen chore solange, bis die orgel mecht angericht werden, das Et in terra auch teusch, wie doctor Martin Luther in die noten gebracht hat, ein gesetze umb das ander singen.

and the two choirs, until the organ might be made ready, [shall] sing the *Et in terra* also in German, as Doctor Martin Luther hath set it to the notes, one stanza after the other.

**Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 78), for feast days:

> Darauf singet der priester das Gloria in excelsis deutsch, wie volget. Ehr sei got, in der hohe. Antiphona angelorum. All ehr und lob sol gottes sein, er ist und heist der höchst allein.

Thereupon the priest singeth the *Gloria in excelsis* in German, as followeth: "Glory be to God on high." The antiphon of the angels: "All honour and praise shall be God's; he is, and is called, the Highest alone."

Hof also marks "All Ehr und Lob" as sung "loco Et in terra" at Pentecost (§8.6.4) and at Christmas, Epiphany and the Purification.

#### 8.7.5 Left out: Advent, Lent, winter

The Gloria was the ordinary most easily dropped. Nördlingen left it out in Advent because the hymns after the epistle were long. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 319):

> Aber den Advent uber wird das Gloria in excelsis sampt dem Et in terra ausgelassen, von wegen der langen geseng nach der epistel.

But through Advent the *Gloria in excelsis* together with the *Et in terra* is left out, by reason of the long songs after the epistle.

At Meiningen it was left out in winter, "when it will grow too long". **Meiningen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnungen*, 1562/1566** (Sehling 2, p. 340):

> hebt das ambt an mit dem Veni sancte spiritus deutsch, darauf singt man einen psalm, das kyrie eleison deutsch, darauf das gloria (welchs man im winter da es zu lang werden will, auslesst) und das deutsch: Et in terra: Allein gott in der höhe sei ehr etc.

[he] beginneth the office with the *Veni sancte Spiritus* in German; thereupon is sung a psalm, the Kyrie eleison in German, thereupon the Gloria (which is left out in winter, when it will grow too long), and the German *Et in terra*, "To God alone on high be glory," etc.

#### 8.7.6 How fixed the Gloria was

The Gloria slot was **fixed**. When a hymn was sung, it was nearly always "Allein Gott in der Höh", with "All Ehr und Lob" as the alternative. The variation was not in which hymn was sung. It was in whether the German hymn replaced the Latin, alternated with it Sunday by Sunday, was inserted into it, or was left out for length or season.

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### 8.8 Between the epistle and the gospel

This is the slot of the gradual, alleluia, tract and sequence. It is the one where German hymns were first put into the Mass (Luther, *Formula missae*: "iuxta gradualia"), and it is by far the most variable. Here the orders let the hymn change with the season, the feast and sometimes the gospel of the Sunday. Most per-Sunday hymn tables in the corpus are tables for this slot. This is the slot that later came to be called the *Hauptlied* or *Graduallied*, though neither word occurs in the corpus (see the Introduction, The hymn database).

#### 8.8.1 The rule: a pure sequence, or a German psalm

The standard formula names the sequence first and "a German psalm" as the alternative. The choice depends on the school, the season, the length of the service, and whether the sequence is "pure". **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 271):

> darauf die epistel gegen dem volk deudsch, darnach ein sequenz, oder deudschen psalm, oder andern geistlichen gesang, wie solches ein jede zeit erfordert.

thereupon the epistle in German toward the people; thereafter a sequence, or a German psalm, or another spiritual song, as every season requireth.

**Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 96):

> so sing alsdann der chor das alleluia mit ainem sequentz, der do reyne und der heyligen geschrift nit entgegen ist. Wo solcher nit verhanden, werdt der sequentz underlassen oder mag gesungen werden ein tractus als dieser: Domine, non secundum peccata nostra facias nobis etc.

then let the choir sing the alleluia with a sequence that is pure and not contrary to holy Scripture. Where such is not at hand, let the sequence be left off; or a tract may be sung, as this: *Domine, non secundum peccata nostra facias nobis*, etc.

The later northern orders name the reason for having both. The Latin trains the scholars and the German lets the congregation sing. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

> Nach der epistel singet man einen sequenz oder alleluja oder tractum, so rein sein, damit die schüler auch im lateinischen gesang geübet, oder auß D. Luthers gesangbuch ein deutscher psalm, auf das die christliche gemein mitsingen, auch ihr gottselige ubung haben möchte.

After the epistle a sequence or alleluia or tract is sung, such as are pure, that the scholars also may be exercised in the Latin song; or out of Doctor Luther's songbook a German psalm, that the Christian congregation may sing along and also have its godly exercise.

This sentence comes from the Lüneburg order of 1564 and passed into Oldenburg (1573). The Northeim order insists the choice is free. **Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 925):

> Nach der epistelen mag auch der chor das haleluja und sequenz, wenn der text rein und die zeit nicht zu kurz ist, singen odder aber anstat des haleluja und sequenz einen psalm mit der ganzen gemeine. Denn es müssen solche dinge frey und keinem gesetz unterworfen sein.

After the epistle the choir may also sing the alleluia and sequence, when the text is pure and the time not too short; or else, in the stead of the alleluia and sequence, a psalm with the whole congregation. For such things must be free and subject to no law.

Honterus's reformation of Kronstadt in Transylvania uses the same test: German songs, or the customary chants, "if they be not repugnant to Scripture". **Kronstadt, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543**, Latin text (Sehling 24, p. 183):

> consuetis cantionibus de tempore utimur neque in iis, quae primitiva servavit ecclesia, quicquam mutuamus, nisi quod post epistolam interdum adhibemus cantiones Germanicas, interdum vero alias consuetas, si non repugnent scripturae.

We use the customary songs of the season, and in those things which the primitive church kept we change nothing; save that after the epistle we sometimes use German songs, and sometimes other customary ones, if they be not repugnant to the Scriptures.

#### 8.8.2 The sequences cut back to the chief feasts

Most of the medieval sequences were dropped. The northern orders keep only three, for the three high feasts of Christ, and always "with its German song". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

> darna vor dat Gradual einen düdesschen Psalm, uth der Schrifft genamen, edder ock ein Gradual, dat men twe verse hefft. De Sequentien unde prosen scholen alle underlaten unde nicht gesungen werden, uthgenamen yn dren groten Festen Christi, alse van Wynachten wente tho Lichtmissen: Grates nunc omnes, mit synem düdeschen gesange.

thereafter, for the gradual, a German psalm taken out of Scripture, or else a gradual that hath two verses. The sequences and prosae shall all be left off and not sung, save on the three great feasts of Christ: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, *Grates nunc omnes*, with its German song.

The Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 and the Hildesheim city order of 1544 carry the same rule, naming the three German songs: "Gelobet seist du" with *Grates nunc omnes*, "Christ lag in Todesbanden" with *Victimae paschali*, and "Nun bitten wir" with *Veni sancte Spiritus*.

Herford gives the reason: the old sequences were godless, and God will be honoured only according to his word. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, pp. 176–177):

> Me hefft in vor tyden in der misse gesungen Gotlose Sequentie sunder jenige beschedenheit. Solkes wille wy nicht mer holden, so wy nu uth Gades gnaden weten, dat God na sinem worde wil geeret sin, und is alle Gadesdenst nichtes werth, de nicht na sinem worde geschüd, Math. 15. So wil wy van Winachten an wente tho Paschen singen de Sequentie Grates nunc etc. und dartüsschen Gelovet sistu, Jhesu Christ und Danck segge wy alle etc., alle mael 2 versch, thom lesten Huic oportet etc.

In former times godless sequences were sung in the Mass without any discretion. Such we will no more keep, since we now know by God's grace that God will be honoured according to his word, and all service of God is worth nothing that is not done according to his word (Matthew 15). So from Christmas unto Easter we will sing the sequence *Grates nunc*, etc., and between, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," and "Thanks say we all," etc., two verses each time, and at the last *Huic oportet*, etc.

> Paschen wente tho Pinxsten schal me singen de Sequentie Victime Paschali etc., darup Christ lach in dodes banden Offt Christ ys erstanden etc. In dem Pinxsten overst schal me singen de sequentie Veni sancte spiritus etc. und darup na twen verschen Nu bidde wy den Hilgen gest, up der hilgen drevoldicheit dach den Introitum Benedicta und Sequentia Benedicta sit sancta, darup Nu bidde wy den Hilgen geist, so me wil. Doch me schal wenich singen van langen Sequentien.

From Easter unto Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Victimae paschali*, etc., thereupon "Christ lay in the bands of death," or "Christ is arisen," etc. But at Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus*, etc., and thereupon, after every two verses, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." On the day of the Holy Trinity, the introit *Benedicta* and the sequence *Benedicta sit sancta*, thereupon "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," if one will. Yet little shall be sung of long sequences.

Wittenberg (1533) is more generous, but it names one sequence it will not have: the "lousy and monkish" sequence of St John the Baptist. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> Auf nativitatis Johannis den sequenz psallite regi nostro etc. Denn den lausigen und monichischen sequenz Sancti Johannis Christi präconis etc. und dergleichen wollen wir nicht haben. Den sequenz de Maria Magdalena laus tibi Christe mag man wol ein mal oder zwei im jar singen auf einen sontag, wen man will. Aber den sequenz de sancta trinitate so oft man will.

On the Nativity of John, the sequence *Psallite regi nostro*, etc. For the lousy and monkish sequence *Sancti Johannis Christi praeconis*, etc., and the like, we will not have. The sequence of Mary Magdalene, *Laus tibi Christe*, may be sung once or twice in the year upon a Sunday, when one will. But the sequence of the Holy Trinity as oft as one will.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach *Auctuarium*, an Interim order, lists the "pure and good" sequences of the chief feasts. On other days it puts a German psalm-hymn in the place of an impure gradual or alleluia. For the Purification its "sequence" is already Luther's German "Mit Fried und Freud". **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 329):

> Die fürnembsten fest, haben ir raine und gute sequenz. Bei den soll man bleiben, als nemblich: Nativitatis Domini: Grates nunc omnes reddamus Domino. Purificationis: Mit frid und freud ich far dahin. Pascha: Victime paschali laudes. De Trinitate: Benedicta semper sancta sit Trinitas. De Spiritu Sancto: Veni, Sancte Spiritus, oder Sancti Spiritus adsit nobis gratia. An den andern feirtagen und festen, die nit raine oder keine sequenz haben, sol man das gradual oder Alleluia singen. Wo aber die nit rain weren, als gemainlich de sanctis, an dero stat sing man dieser psalm einen: Ein feste burg ist unser Gott etc. Wer Gott nit mit uns diese zeit etc. Wol dem, der in Gottes forcht steht etc. Aus tiefer not etc. Mensch, wilt du leben seliglich etc. Dan mag auch die gradualia und alleluia abwechseln an sontagen und gemelter psalmen ainen an dero stat singen von des volks wegen.

The chiefest feasts have their pure and good sequences. By these one shall abide, namely: the Nativity of the Lord, *Grates nunc omnes reddamus Domino*; the Purification, "In peace and joy I now depart"; Easter, *Victimae paschali laudes*; of the Trinity, *Benedicta semper sancta sit Trinitas*; of the Holy Ghost, *Veni, Sancte Spiritus*, or *Sancti Spiritus adsit nobis gratia*. On the other holy days and feasts, that have no pure sequences or none, the gradual or alleluia shall be sung. But where these were not pure, as commonly of the saints, let one of these psalms be sung in their stead: "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; "Were God not with us at this time," etc.; "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.; "Out of the depths," etc.; "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc. Then also on Sundays the graduals and alleluias may be changed about, and one of the said psalms sung in their stead, for the people's sake.

#### 8.8.3 Farced sequences: Latin verses and German stanzas by turns

At the three high feasts the northern and Saxon orders sang the Latin sequence with the stanzas of a German *Leise* sung between its verses, by the people or the whole church. The pairs are always the same:

| Season | Latin sequence | German hymn sung between |
|---|---|---|
| Christmas to Candlemas | *Grates nunc omnes* | "Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ" (at Herford also "Dank sagen wir alle") |
| Easter to Ascension or Pentecost | *Victimae paschali* | "Christ lag in Todesbanden" or "Christ ist erstanden" |
| Pentecost | *Veni sancte Spiritus* | "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" |
| Trinity (some orders) | *Benedicta semper sit Trinitas* | "Nun bitten wir" (Herford) or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" (Anhalt) |

The Hamburg order of 1529 gives the scheme exactly. *Grates* is sung three times, each time followed by two German stanzas. *Huic oportet* is followed by the last stanza. At Easter a stanza of "Christ lag" comes after every verse of *Victimae*. At Pentecost a German stanza of "Nun bitten" comes after every two Latin verses of *Veni sancte*. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 530):

> Van winachten bet up purificationis schalme singen de sequentie grates nunc omnes etc. und mit sulker wise dar twischen dat leed: Gelavet sistu Jesu Christ etc. Ersten schalme singen Grates, dar up twe dudesche versche, noch eins Grates und twe ander dudesche versche, ock tom drudden mal Grates und twe ander dudesche versche. Tom lesten Huic oportet mit dem lesten dudeschen versche. Van paschen bet up pinxsten schallme singen de snquentie Victime pascali,

> also dat me na allen verschen singe ock ein versch van dem dudeschen lede Christ lach in dodes banden, dat leed averst Christ is uperstanden, schal me singen na wontliker wise, wen me de predike anhevet. In pinxsten schalme singen de sequentie Veni sancte spiritus und na twen latinschen verschen ein dudesch versch van dem lede: Nu bidde wi den hilligen geest etc.

From Christmas unto the Purification shall be sung the sequence *Grates nunc omnes*, etc., and after this manner, between, the song "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc. First *Grates* shall be sung, thereupon two German verses; once more *Grates* and two other German verses; also the third time *Grates* and two other German verses. At the last *Huic oportet*, with the last German verse. From Easter unto Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Victimae paschali*, so that after every verse one also sing a verse of the German song "Christ lay in the bands of death." But the song "Christ is arisen" shall be sung after the accustomed manner when the sermon is begun. At Pentecost shall be sung the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus*, and after every two Latin verses a German verse of the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

The Prussian order of 1568 has the same scheme and adds Trinity. The Trinity sequence is to alternate Sunday by Sunday with a German psalm, "that the German songs may remain in the church". **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

> Nach der epistel singet man die festtage die sequenzen, wo die rein sind, als weihnachten: Grates nunc omnes, und wenn das einmal gesungen, darauf mit der gemeine die zwei ersten verse im: Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ etc., wenn es zum andern mal gesungen, abermals zwe versen im selbigen psalmen. Wenn nu darauf gesungen ist: Huic oportet, ut canamus cum angelis sollen darauf folgen die drei letzten vers und soll das von weihnachten gehalten werden bis auf Purificationis. Ostern singet man den sequenz: Victimae paschali laudes, und darunter: Christ lag in todesbanden, vers um vers. In pfingsten singet man: Veni sancte spiritus et emitte coelitus, etc. und auf zwen lateinische vers allezeit einen deutschen aus dem schönen gesang: Nu bitten wir den heilgen geist etc. Trinitatis singet man den sequenz: Benedicta semper sit trinitas, und mag man denselbigen den folgenden sonntag, einen um den andern, mit einem deutschen psalm abwechseln, dass man einen sonntag gemelten sequenz, den andern einen deutschen psalm singet, damit die deutschen geseng in der kirchen bleiben.

After the epistle, on the feast days, the sequences are sung where they are pure: as at Christmas, *Grates nunc omnes*; and when that hath been sung once, thereupon with the congregation the two first verses of "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.; when it is sung the second time, again two verses of the same psalm. When *Huic oportet, ut canamus cum angelis* hath then been sung, the three last verses shall follow; and this shall be kept from Christmas unto the Purification. At Easter the sequence *Victimae paschali laudes* is sung, and among it "Christ lay in the bands of death," verse by verse. At Pentecost is sung *Veni sancte Spiritus et emitte coelitus*, etc., and after two Latin verses always one German verse out of the fair song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. On Trinity the sequence *Benedicta semper sit Trinitas* is sung; and the same may be changed on the following Sundays, one after the other, with a German psalm, so that one Sunday the said sequence is sung, the other a German psalm, that the German songs may remain in the church.

In Mecklenburg the organ played the Latin verses and the cantor sang the German stanzas in between. The Latin text was not sung at all; the organ stood for it. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 152):

> In den winachten unde vort bet to Purificationis schal me singen de sequentie: Grates nunc omnes, mit düsser wise. Wor ein orgel is, dar sla de organiste Grates. Dar na holde he stille unde de cantor vange an: Gelavet sistu. Dar na dat ander versch, des ewigen vaders, unde singe denn: Grates nunc omnes. Dar na sleit wedder de organiste Grates. […] In den ostern ock also, de organiste sla: Victime. De cantor höve an twe de ersten versche: Christ lach in dodes banden.

At Christmas and onward unto the Purification the sequence *Grates nunc omnes* shall be sung after this manner. Where there is an organ, let the organist play *Grates*. Thereafter let him hold still, and the cantor begin "Praised be thou." Thereafter the other verse, "Of the eternal Father," and then sing *Grates nunc omnes*. Thereafter the organist playeth *Grates* again. […] At Easter likewise: let the organist play *Victimae*; let the cantor begin the two first verses of "Christ lay in the bands of death."

The same Mecklenburg order sang Luther's Advent hymn "Nun komm der Heiden Heiland" (the German *Veni redemptor*) after the Advent alleluia.

The Calenberg order sets the German stanzas "between every verse". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 793):

> Den sequenz belangen, sol man auf das haleluja denselbigen auch singen, doch also, das man von Ostern bis auf die Pfingsten singe: Victime paschali, von Pfingsten bis auf Trinitatis: Veni, sancte Spiritus, von Trinitatis, solange es den pfarherrn gut dünkt, den sequenz de sancta Trinitate, von den Weinachten bis purificationis Marie Grates nunc omnes. Man sol aber hie zwischen einem iden fers die gewönliche deutsche gesenge singen, als auf Ostern Christ ist erstanden, auf die Pfingsten Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist, auf die Weinachten Gelobet seiestu, Jhesu Christ etc.

Touching the sequence, one shall sing the same also after the alleluia; yet so that from Easter unto Pentecost one sing *Victimae paschali*; from Pentecost unto Trinity, *Veni, sancte Spiritus*; from Trinity, as long as it seemeth good to the pastor, the sequence of the Holy Trinity; from Christmas unto the Purification of Mary, *Grates nunc omnes*. But here, between every verse, one shall sing the customary German songs: at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Christmas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc.

At Harzgerode the people "sang in" the German stanzas, and on ordinary Sundays a German song took the place of the sequence. On the feasts of Our Lady the hymn was "Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn". **Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?)** (Sehling 2, p. 586):

> zu weinachten werden in der sequenz Grates nunc omnes, die deutschen gesetz Gelobet seistu mit dem volgenden, vom volk mit drein gesungen, auf Oestern die sequenz Victime paschali sampt dem Christ ist erstanden, pfingsten die sequenz Veni sancte spiritus et Emitte celitus und darzu die gesetz Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist mit den andern, auf die gemeine sontag an stat des sequenz ein deutsch lied ader psalm, auf unser frauen fest das lied Her Christ der einig gots son.

At Christmas, in the sequence *Grates nunc omnes*, the German stanzas "Praised be thou" with those following are sung in among it by the people; at Easter the sequence *Victimae paschali* together with "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost the sequence *Veni sancte Spiritus et emitte coelitus*, and thereto the stanzas "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" with the others; on the common Sundays, in the stead of the sequence, a German song or psalm; on the feasts of Our Lady the song "Lord Christ, the only Son of God."

The Anhalt *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge* calls this "weaving in". **Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551** (Sehling 2, p. 555):

> An die hohe festage als christag, ostern, pfingsten und trinitatis mag man die mess und vesper in latin und discant singen. Doch das under die sequentien vor dem evangelio die deudsche […] gesenge, zu den festagen gehorig, mit angeflochten, und da und sunst allenthalben vor der predig des evangelii der glaube zu deudsch gesungen werde.

On the high feast days, as Christmas, Easter, Pentecost and Trinity, one may sing the Mass and vespers in Latin and in descant. Yet so that the German songs belonging to the feast days be woven in among the sequences before the gospel, and that there and everywhere else, before the sermon on the gospel, the creed be sung in German.

In the Hadersleben articles of 1528 the Latin sequences of the great feasts are allowed "and the *Leisen* in them". **Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528** (Sehling 23, p. 64):

> Eth schal ock friig sin, dat sie in den groten festen mögen Gloria in excelsis up latin singen, des gelicken Alleluya und eine sequentien, alse Grates nunc omnes, Victime Paschali, Veni Sancte Spiritus, und de leyssen darinn, item dat latinische Patrem, prefatien, Sanctus unnd Agnus Dei, doch dat aleine up di groten feste.

It shall also be free for them on the great feasts to sing the *Gloria in excelsis* in Latin, likewise the alleluia and a sequence, as *Grates nunc omnes*, *Victimae paschali*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, and the *Leisen* therein; item the Latin *Patrem*, prefaces, *Sanctus* and *Agnus Dei*; yet only on the great feasts.

#### 8.8.4 German sequences

Some orders sang the sequence itself in German prose, to the Latin melody. The Calenberg printed Masses of 1542 give "Danksagen wir alle Gott" as the Christmas sequence (the German *Grates*), followed by "Gelobet seist du". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542**, the German Christmas Mass (Sehling 6/2, p. 820):

> Sequenz. [Noten:] Danksagen wir alle Got, unserm Herrn Christo, der uns mit seinem wort hat erleuchtet, hat uns erlöset mit seim blut von des teufels gewalte. Den sollen wir alle mit seinen engeln loben mit schalle singend: Preis sey Gott in

> der höhe [Ende der Noten]. Ein lobgesang von der geburt Christi.

Sequence. [Notes:] "Thanks say we all to God, our Lord Christ, who hath enlightened us with his word, hath redeemed us with his blood from the power of the devil. Him shall we all praise with his angels, with sound, singing: Praise be to God on high" [end of notes]. A song of praise of the birth of Christ.

The same Calenberg Masses have the Easter sequence "Laßt uns Christen alle singen" with "Christ ist erstanden" sung between its verses. The Pentecost sequence is "Komm, du Tröster, heiliger Geist" with "Nun bitten wir" "between every verse". The Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist) printed the same German sequences in its songbook appendix (Sehling 8, pp. 464–469). At Hof the Easter sequence was sung in German as "Wir Christen opfern allesamt". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 440):

> Post epistolam: Christ lag in todesbanden, oder der sequenz Victimae paschali, deudsch: Wir christen opfern allesambt.

After the epistle: "Christ lay in the bands of death," or the sequence *Victimae paschali* in German, "We Christians offer all together."

#### 8.8.5 A hymn in the place of the gradual

Calenberg's German Masses replace the gradual and alleluia outright on two days. At the Purification the hymn is Simeon's song in Luther's version (Sehling 6/2, p. 823):

> Vor das gradual und alleluja sing man den gesang Simeonis wie volgt. [Noten:] Mit fried und freud ich far dahin in Gottes wille.

For the gradual and alleluia let the song of Simeon be sung, as followeth. [Notes:] "In peace and joy I now depart, according to God's will."

In the Passion Mass Psalm 51 replaces the sequence (Sehling 6/2, p. 825):

> Anstat des sequenz singe man den volgenden psalm. Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott, nach deiner grossen barmherzigkeit!

In the stead of the sequence let the following psalm be sung: "Have mercy on me, O Lord God, after thy great mercy!"

#### 8.8.6 A German psalm that "rhymes with the gospel"

The fullest rule for choosing the hymn is in Pomerania (1542) and Mecklenburg (1545). On ordinary Sundays the German psalm-hymn is to be chosen by the matter of the Sunday gospel. Faith and grace, Christ's enemies, good works and the right use of earthly goods each have their hymns. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> effte up die andern sondage einen psalm, de sick upt evangelium rimet so vele mogelick, alse wenn dat evangelium ludet vam loven und der gnade, so singe me, idt is dat heil uns kamen her, item dorch Adams val oder dergeliken, wenn averst dat evangelion ludet van den godtlosen joden und huchelern, wo se wedder Christum handlen, so singe me, idt sprecket der unwise munt wol, item ach godt van hemmel; wenn idt van guden werken ludet, de uns godt gebut, so singe me, herr wol werd wohnen etc. und andere psalme, de man wet upt bequemest to gebruken.

or on the other Sundays a psalm that rhymeth with the gospel as much as may be: as, when the gospel speaketh of faith and of grace, let "Salvation now is come to us" be sung, item "Through Adam's fall," or the like; but when the gospel speaketh of the godless Jews and hypocrites, how they deal against Christ, let "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed" be sung, item "Ah God, from heaven"; when it speaketh of good works which God commandeth us, let "Lord, who shall dwell," etc. be sung; and other psalms which one knoweth to use most fitly.

**Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 153):

> Up den dörpern schal me stedes einen düdeschen psalm singen, wo me in den steden to tiden ock don mach. Unde sundergen de psalm, de sick up dat hillige evangelion rimen. Als wen dat evangelion ludet van dem geloven und der gnade, so singe me: Idt is dat heil uns kamen her etc., Dorch Adams vall. So idt is ein lere unses heilandes, so singe me: Gades rechte und wunderdat. Ludet dat evangelion van den jöden, wo se wedder Christum handelen, so singe me: Idt

> sprickt der unwise mundt wol, Ach godt, van hemmel sü darin, Wo godt de here nicht bi uns hölt, und den II. psalm: Help godt, wo geit dat jümmer to. Wen idt van guden werken ludet, so singe men: Dit sint de hilligen tein gebot, Wol dem, de in gades fruchten steit, Here, wol wert wanen in diner hütten [...]. Wenn dat evangelion eine lere is, van dem rechten gebruke düsser vorgenklicken dinge, so singe me: Wo godt nicht sülvest dat hus uprichtet.

In the villages a German psalm shall always be sung, as may also at times be done in the towns; and especially the psalms that rhyme with the holy gospel. As, when the gospel speaketh of faith and of grace, let "Salvation now is come to us," etc., "Through Adam's fall," be sung. If it be a teaching of our Saviour, let "God's justice and wondrous deed" be sung. If the gospel speak of the Jews, how they deal against Christ, let "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," "Ah God, from heaven look down," "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," and the second psalm, "Help, God, how goeth it ever so," be sung. When it speaketh of good works, let "These are the holy ten commandments," "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," "Lord, who shall dwell in thy tabernacle" [...] be sung. When the gospel is a teaching of the right use of these transitory things, let "Except God himself build the house" be sung.

Later orders keep the rule in shorter form. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 438):

> Hirup singet de chor de sequentiam de tempore vel feste, edder tractum, edder to tiden ein alleluia mit dem gradual, edder up de sondage einen düdischen psalm, de sick mit dem evangelio rimet. Up de sondage na Trinitatis schal men alle maente de sequentiam de trinitate singen. Wenn apostel dage, decollationis Iohannis, Mariae Magdalenae, conversionis Pauli, der hiligen marterer vallen, schal men des sondages to vörne, edder dar na, alse idt gelegen, desülvige sequentiam singen, alse se Lossius gesettet hefft, up dat de olden herliken gesenge de apostolis, evangelistis etc. nicht genzlick vorla[ren werden].

Hereupon the choir singeth the sequence of the season or of the feast, or the tract, or at times an alleluia with the gradual, or on the Sundays a German psalm that rhymeth with the gospel. On the Sundays after Trinity the sequence of the Trinity shall be sung every month. When apostles' days, the Beheading of John, Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the holy martyrs fall, the same sequence shall be sung on the Sunday before or after, as it falleth, as Lossius hath set them; that the old glorious songs of the apostles, evangelists, etc. be not wholly lost.

**Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71):

> Ein deuzscher psalm nach der zeitgelegenheit oder der sich mit dem evangelio reimet.

A German psalm according to the occasion of the season, or one that rhymeth with the gospel.

**Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578** (Sehling 1, p. 693). This is the order whose one-hymn-per-Sunday table is printed in `hymns.db`:

> Singet die gemein ein deutsch lied, das sich uf die zeit und evangelium schicket, 5. Als dominica 1. adventus: Nun kom der heiden heiland.

The congregation singeth a German song that fitteth the season and the gospel; as on the first Sunday of Advent, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen."

At Weissenfels even the festal Mass sung in figured music kept this German hymn. **Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578** (Sehling 1, p. 694):

> Uf die fest werden vorgenannte gesenge alle figuraliter gesungen, ohne die deutschen lieder nach der epistel in der messen, und nach dem hymno in der vespern.

On the feasts the aforenamed songs are all sung in figured music, save the German songs after the epistle in the Mass and after the hymn in the vespers.

**Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 156):

> Nach der epistel soll man einen sequenz oder halleluja de tempore oder einen deutschen psalmen, der mit dem text oder inhalt des evangelii ubereinkomet, singen.

After the epistle one shall sing a sequence or alleluia of the season, or a German psalm that agreeth with the text or content of the gospel.

### 8.8.7 Sunday and season tables for this slot

Many orders fix the hymn for this slot by season, and some by Sunday. The tables of Pomerania (1569), Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1565), Weissenfels (1578), Mansfeld (1580) and Hohenlohe (1596) are extracted in `hymns.db` and described in the Introduction (The hymn database). They are not repeated here, but Appendix 8.A sets out the hymn that they and the old hymnals most often give to each Sunday and feast. The following orders have tables that are not in `hymns.db`.

**Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564**, Low German (Sehling 22, pp. 530–531). The table runs by season. Holy Week has no hymn in this slot; instead, a Passion hymn is split around the sermon. The order closes with an open clause for the rest of the year:

> Na der Episteln singet man Alleluia und de Sequentie oder sunst ein Ledt, wie de hir naeinander verordent sint. Im Advent: Alleluia. Darup: Herr Christ, de einige Godes Son, etc. Up Winachten bet up Purificat[ionis]: Alleluia. Grates nunc omnes […] Darup: Gelovet s[e]istu Jhesu Christ […] Up Purificationis oder Lichtmesse Na dem Alleluia: Mit fred und freud ick far dahen, etc. In der Fasten: Midden wy im leven sint mit dem dod umfangen, etc. Up Annunciationis und Visitationis: Her Christ, de einige Godes Son, Vader in ewicheit, etc.

After the epistle the alleluia is sung, and the sequence, or else a song, as they are here ordained one after another. In Advent: alleluia; thereupon "Lord Christ, the only Son of God," etc. From Christmas unto the Purification: alleluia, *Grates nunc omnes* […]; thereupon "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ" […]. On the Purification or Candlemas, after the alleluia, "In peace and joy I now depart," etc. In Lent: "In the midst of life we are compassed with death," etc. On the Annunciation and the Visitation: "Lord Christ, the only Son of God, Father in eternity," etc.

> Up Ostern beth up Hemelfarth: Alleluia. Darup volget Victimae Paschali laudes etc., Und singet dat volck dartwischen: Christ is upgestanden, oder man singe: Christ lag in dodesbanden […] Hemelfart: Alleluia. Nu freuwet iw, leven Christen gemein, etc. […] Pingsten: Alleluia. Nu bidde wy den hilligen Geist, etc. Trinitatis: God, de Vader, wone uns by, etc. Michaelis: Nu lave mine seele den Heren, etc. Up andere thijde nemet man, wat man will und sick am be[sten schicket].

From Easter unto the Ascension: alleluia; thereupon followeth *Victimae paschali laudes*, etc., and the people sing between: "Christ is arisen"; or one singeth "Christ lay in the bands of death" […]. The Ascension: alleluia, "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc. […] Pentecost: alleluia, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. Trinity: "God the Father be with us," etc. Michaelmas: "Now praise, my soul, the Lord," etc. At other times one taketh what one will and what fitteth best.

**Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551** (Sehling 2, p. 556). This order gives hymns by season for three slots: before the early sermon, in the Mass before the gospel, and before the vesper sermon. For the Trinity season it tells the Mass to keep one hymn for about four Sundays running, so that the congregation may learn it:

> Nach Trinitatis. Bis auf die advent singe man allezeit vor der frupredig: Nu bitten wir den heiligen, in der messen aber sol man diese nachfolgende gesenge vor dem evangelio, etwan vier sontag nach einander bis auf den advent singen, damit die gemein des zu leichtlicher lerne und behalde: Erbarm dich mein o herre gott, Vater unser im himelreich, Es ist das heil uns komen her, etvan halb und die ander helft darnach, Ach got von himel sich drein, Es spricht der unweiser mund wol, Ein feste burg, Es wolt uns got gnedig sein, Aus tiefer not, Ich rufe zu dir her Jesu Christ und dergleichen.

After Trinity. Until Advent let "Now pray we the Holy [Ghost]" be sung always before the early sermon; but in the Mass these following songs shall be sung before the gospel, some four Sundays one after another, until Advent, that the congregation may the more easily learn and keep them: "Have mercy on me, O Lord God"; "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; "Salvation now is come to us" (about half, and the other half afterward); "Ah God, from heaven look down"; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed"; "A mighty fortress"; "May God be gracious unto us"; "Out of the depths"; "I call to thee, Lord Jesu Christ"; and the like.

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65). Here the alleluia is sung "with the melody rhymed to" the German psalm that follows. The list is to be rotated, "as is the use at Königsberg":

> Volgt Halleluja mit der melodei gereimet auf den deudschen psalmen, so man singen wil, als: Frölich wöllen wir halleluja singen. Eine feste burg ist unser got. Von der taufe Christi, doctoris Martini lied, item desselbigen Vater unser im himelreich. Item, Ach vater unser, der du bist etc. Abzuwechseln wie dann zu Königsberg in ubung ist etc. In den festen

> hats eigenes, als uf Ostern: Christ lag in todes banden. Item, Jesus Christ unser heiland. Auf Pfingsten: Kom, got schöpfer, heiliger geist. Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist. In Weihnachten: Gelobet seistu Jesu Christ. Item, Grates nunc omnes. Dank sagen wir nu alle etc.

There followeth the alleluia, with the melody rhymed to the German psalm that one will sing, as: "Joyfully will we sing alleluia"; "A mighty fortress is our God"; Doctor Martin's song of the baptism of Christ; item his "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; item "Ah Father of ours, who art," etc. To be changed about, as is the use at Königsberg, etc. On the feasts there is proper matter, as at Easter "Christ lay in the bands of death," item "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; at Pentecost, "Come, God Creator, Holy Ghost," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Christmas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," item *Grates nunc omnes*, "Thanks say we now all," etc.

**Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 323). The order prints a Sunday list for the psalm after the epistle, taken from Naumburg. It then leaves the choice open:

> Nach gelegenhait der zeit, nachdem es in der christenhait zustehet, mag man wol andere, die bequemer sich zu jeder zeit schicken, an diser stad bisweilen nemen, desgleichen auch, wenn man mensur singet.

According to the occasion of the time, as it standeth in Christendom, one may well take at times others in this place, that fit themselves more fitly to every season; likewise also when one singeth measured music.

The Nördlingen order of 1579 prints its own list and fits it to the sermon as well. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 386):

> Wo aber den sechsten Januarii oder den sonntag vor dem Obersttag von der taufe Christi geprediget, solle der psalm Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam etc. gesungen werden. Von Purificationis bis uf den sonntag Septuagesima: Mit frid und freud ich fahr dahin etc.

But where on the sixth of January, or the Sunday before Epiphany, it is preached of the baptism of Christ, the psalm "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc. shall be sung. From the Purification unto the Sunday Septuagesima, "In peace and joy I now depart," etc.

**Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555** (Sehling 1, pp. 642–643). This order lists two German hymns for each Sunday. It says they are arranged by the sense of the Sunday epistles and gospels, and may give way to Latin on the high feasts:

> Haec cantica germanica iuxta epistolarum et evangeliorum dominicalium sensum ordinata sunt, quae aliquando latinis canticis mutari possunt ad exercitium scholasticorum ad musicam pracipue solennibus festis ubi responsoria, hymni, introitus, gradualia pura assueto ordine cani possunt.

These German songs are ordered according to the sense of the Sunday epistles and gospels, and may sometimes be changed for Latin songs for the exercise of the scholars in music, chiefly on the solemn feasts, when pure responsories, hymns, introits and graduals may be sung in the accustomed order.

The Mansfeld table of 1580 goes furthest toward gospel narrative hymns. For the first Sunday after Trinity, whose gospel is Dives and Lazarus, it adds a ballad of the rich man, marked * as not by Luther. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 238):

> Domin. I. post trinitatis. Gott der vater wohne uns bei, etc. Ach gott von himel sich darein etc. *Es war einmal ein reicher man.

The first Sunday after Trinity: "God the Father be with us," etc.; "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; *"There was once a rich man."

On Oculi, Mansfeld puts the litany in the place of the sequence (Sehling 2, p. 238):

> Hie sol auch die litanei gesungen werden, an stat des sequenz, wenn das volk zusammen komen ist.

Here also the litany shall be sung, in the stead of the sequence, when the people are come together.

#### 8.8.8 Why the hymn might not change: an unknown tune

Hof's Sunday table shows why a new hymn could not always be sung. For Septuagesima it offers a familiar alternative, because the congregation did not know the new hymn and "heareth only the tune". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 436):

> Post epistolam: Herr Got, dein namen rufn wir, oder dafür Ach Gott vom himel sih darein, weil das vorgehend sowol des künftigen sontagsgesang dem gemeinen man unbekant. und er allein den ton höret.

After the epistle: "Lord God, we call upon thy name," or instead "Ah God, from heaven look down," because the foregoing, as also the song of the coming Sunday, is unknown to the common man, and he heareth only the tune.

For Advent the same table offers a shorter hymn "when it is very cold", and keeps the longer one for the communion (Sehling 11, p. 432):

> Post epistolam: Durch Adams fall ist ganz verderbt oder wanns sehr kalt: Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu. Ita ut praecedens sub communionem reservetur. vel etiam sequentia: Als der gutige Got vollenden wolt.

After the epistle: "Through Adam's fall is all corrupt," or, when it is very cold, "I call to thee, Lord Jesu"; so that the foregoing be kept back for the communion; or else the sequence "When the good God would fulfil."

Wittgenstein rotated its psalm-hymns for the opposite reason: so that the congregation would not stay "on one side" and leave the other fine psalms unlearned. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 103):

> Solche ordnung behelt man etliche sontage nach den hohen festen. Wenn aber solche zeit auß ist, soll man an stadt der vorigen gesenge andere geistliche deutsche psalmen singen also, das gleichwoll diese ordnung unnd gantze action fur und fur in ihrem wesen bleibe und erhalten werde. Unnd sollen die pastores auff den dörffern ihr völcklin vermanen und underweisen, das sie solche psalmen mit singen lernen, als da seind: Durch Adams fall etc. Diß sind die heiligen zehen gebot etc. Ich ruff dich an, herr Jesu Christ etc. Nun frewt euch, lieben christen gemein etc. Auß tieffer nott schrey ich zu dir etc. Erbarm dich mein, o herre Gott etc. Ein feste burg ist unser Gott etc. Wo Gott, der herr, nicht bey uns helt etc. Ach Gott, vonn himel sih darein etc. Es spricht der unweisen mund woll etc., welcher psalmen man jehands einen umb den andern singen soll, damit man nicht allezeit auff einer seiten bleibe und die schönen psalmen ungelernet bleiben.

This order is kept some Sundays after the high feasts. But when that time is out, in the stead of the foregoing songs other spiritual German psalms shall be sung, so that nevertheless this order and the whole action remain and be kept in its being continually. And the pastors in the villages shall exhort and instruct their little folk to learn to sing along such psalms, as these are: "Through Adam's fall," etc.; "These are the holy ten commandments," etc.; "I call upon thee, Lord Jesu Christ," etc.; "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc.; "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc.; "Have mercy on me, O Lord God," etc.; "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc.; "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; "The mouth of the unwise saith indeed," etc.; of which psalms one shall sing one after the other in turn, that one abide not always on one side and the fair psalms remain unlearned.

#### 8.8.9 The litany in this slot

Several orders put a litany between the epistle and the gospel. Lüneburg used a Kyrie-litany hymn, "Nim von uns, Herr Gott". It gave way when there were children to baptize, and baptism was then held between the epistle and the gospel. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 543–544):

> Nach der epistel singet man einen sequenz oder alleluja, Lobet den Herrn, oder Nim, Herre Gott, von uns all unser sünde und missethat, und der priester das gebet, darin die litania begrieffen.

After the epistle a sequence or alleluia is sung, "Praise ye the Lord," or "Take from us, Lord God, all our sin and misdeed," and the priest [prayeth] the prayer wherein the litany is comprised.

> Wenn aber die zeit zu kurz fellet oder kinder zu teufen verhanden, so kan entweder der sequenz oder der gesang: Nim von uns, Herr Gott etc. oder der tractus ein oder alle ausgelassen werden. So denn kinder zu teufen verhanden, die sollen für der lection des evangelii getauft werden. So aber keine kinder zu teufen verhanden oder sonst so viel zeit ist, sol die litania stets gesungen werden.

But when the time falleth too short, or there be children to baptize, then either the sequence or the song "Take from us, Lord God," etc., or the tract, one or all, may be left out. When, then, there be children to baptize, they shall be baptized before the

lesson of the gospel. But when there be no children to baptize, or there is otherwise time enough, the litany shall always be sung.

**Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 88), which prints the same hymn:

> Folgends die sequentia pro tempore, mit dem alleluia, oder auf den gemeinen sontagen ein christlicher psalm, unterzeiten die letania. Oder um der kurze willen diese letania. Nim von uns, lieber herr, Unser sünd und missethat.

Following, the sequence of the season with the alleluia; or on the common Sundays a Christian psalm; at times the litany; or, for brevity's sake, this litany: "Take from us, dear Lord, our sin and misdeed."

Regensburg used the Prussian litany with "Erhalt uns, Herr" as its appendix, and the sequence only when there was figured music. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 420):

> Darnach singt der chor die zu Preußen gesetzten letanei mit dem anhang: Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem wort etc. […] An sunderlichen festen aber pflegt man je zu weilen von kurz wegen, so oft man figurirt, für die letanei die alleluia und sequenz de tempore zu nemen.

Thereafter the choir singeth the litany set forth in Prussia, with the appendix "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc. […] But on special feasts it is the custom now and then, for brevity's sake, as oft as figured music is sung, to take the alleluia and sequence of the season in the stead of the litany.

The later Regensburg order even calls "Erhalt uns" the "sequence of the season". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 462):

> darauf singt der chor sequentiam de tempore: Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem wort, oder sonst etwas deudsches.

thereupon the choir singeth the sequence of the season: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," or else something German.

The Litany as a rite, with its forms, singers and days, is treated in Chapter 13, §13.22.

#### 8.8.10 How fixed the slot was

This slot was **variable**. At the three high feasts it was fixed by the farced sequence and its *Leise*. Through the rest of the year practice ran along a scale:

1. A short list rotated to teach the people (Anhalt 1551, Prussia 1544, Wittgenstein 1563).
2. Seasonal assignment (Neuenrade 1564, Mansfeld, Nördlingen 1579).
3. A Sunday-by-Sunday table matched to the gospel (Pirna 1555, Weissenfels 1578, Hof 1592, Pomerania 1569).
4. The rule of Pomerania 1542 and Mecklenburg 1545, which chooses by the matter of the gospel without a fixed table.

The Latin alternatives (sequence, alleluia, tract) and the litany came in at the edges.

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### 8.9 The creed: "Wir glauben all"

The creed slot is among the most fixed in the corpus. Luther's "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" was sung by the people, either instead of the Latin *Patrem* or after it. It is named in more orders than any other hymn except "Nun bitten" and the communion hymns. The alternatives are few:

- the Apostles' Creed sung "von Wort zu Wort" ("Ich glaub an Gott Vater"), a sung prose form;
- a German Nicene Creed;
- rarely, the Athanasian Creed in German;
- in Advent at Schweinfurt, "Wir glauben" in the place of "Nun bitten" (§8.9.4).

What varies is where the creed stands and what it is used for.

The creed in the order of the Mass, Nicene or Apostles', is treated in Chapter 2, §2.9.

#### 8.9.1 After the gospel, with or instead of the Latin *Patrem*

The *Deutsche Messe* set the pattern: "Nach dem evangelio singt die ganze kirche den glauben zu deudsch: Wir gleuben all an einen gott" (§8.3.2). Where the Latin was kept, the people sang the German creed after it, or even at the same time as it. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 72):

> Nach dem evangelio sol der priester das Credo und der chor das Patrem lateinisch singen oder, wo kein chor ist, mag es der priester selbs singen oder sprechen und das volk dieweil das teutsch gesang: Wir glauben all in einen Gott lassen singen.

After the gospel the priest shall sing the *Credo* and the choir the *Patrem* in Latin; or, where there is no choir, the priest may sing or say it himself, and meanwhile let the people sing the German song "We all believe in one God."

At Aschersleben the credal slot rotated over four Sundays: German, Latin with the *Patrem*, figured music, and the litany. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 478):

> Es soll aber auch der cantor einen sontag teutsch, den andern lateinisch singen, darzu dan das patrem auch gehört, den dritten sontag figuriren, und den vierten die litaniam singen.

The cantor shall also sing one Sunday in German, the other in Latin (whereto the *Patrem* also belongeth), the third Sunday figured music, and the fourth sing the litany.

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) allows three German creeds, and on occasion the German *Grates nunc omnes* in their place. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

> Auf verlesung des evangelii wird gesungen das symbolum apostolicum teutsch, von wort zu wort, oder wie es Doctor Luther paraphrastice in gesangsweise gestelt hat, oder das symbolum Nicenum teutsch. Man mag auch je bisweilen nach dem evangelio das teutsch Grates nunc omnes, oder einen andern kurzen gesang singen und darauf das symbolum Nicenum oder Athanasianum mit klarer stimm dem volk für dem altar fürlesen.

Upon the reading of the gospel the Apostles' Creed is sung in German, word for word; or as Doctor Luther hath set it in paraphrase after the manner of a song; or the Nicene Creed in German. One may also now and then, after the gospel, sing the German *Grates nunc omnes*, or another short song, and thereupon read the Nicene or the Athanasian Creed to the people before the altar with a clear voice.

At Brieg (1592) the Latin Nicene Creed alternated Sunday by Sunday with the Athanasian Creed in German, taken from Triller's songbook. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

> nach der epistel einen deutschen gesang aus dem gesangbüchlein des herrn doctoris Lutheri, nach dem evangelio das Symbolum Nicaenum oder Athanasii, einen sontag latine, den andern sontag das Symbolum Athanasii deutsch, aus des Trilleri gesangbüchlein.

after the epistle a German song out of the songbook of Doctor Luther; after the gospel the Nicene or Athanasian Creed, one Sunday in Latin, the other Sunday the Athanasian Creed in German, out of Triller's songbook.

In the Prussian villages the creed-hymn is followed at once by "Nun bitten", so the two together lead into the sermon. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 83):

> auf das evangelium singet man: Wir glauben all an einen gott etc. und nach denselbigen: Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist etc.

after the gospel is sung "We all believe in one God," etc., and after the same, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

### 8.9.2 After the sermon: the creed as the offertory

In Bugenhagen's orders the sermon comes between the gospel and the creed. After it the people sing the creed while the communicants go into the choir and the priest prepares the bread and wine. The creed-hymn thus fills the slot of the old offertory. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 528):

> Wen de predicante afsticht, so singet de prester vor dem altar na dem altar gewendt: Ick love an einen godt. So singet dat volk edder chor versch umme versch dat ganze Simbolum Nicenum ut, unde dar to Wi loven all in einen godt etc. De

> wile gan de communicanten in dat chor, de frouwen und junckfrouwen an der luchter siden, besundergen, und de mans und knechte an der rechten siden besundergen und de prester bereidet brodt und win, und wes dar to nodt is.

When the preacher cometh down, the priest before the altar, turned toward the altar, singeth: "I believe in one God." Then the people or the choir sing the whole Nicene Creed through, verse by verse, and thereto "We all believe in one God," etc. Meanwhile the communicants go into the choir, the women and maidens on the left side apart, and the men and servants on the right side apart; and the priest prepareth bread and wine, and what is needful thereto.

In the Braunschweig order of 1528 the creed stood before the sermon, and a German psalm or song after the sermon did this work. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 441):

> Wen de predicante affstiget, so singet me eynen düdeschen psalm edder led, dewile gan de communicanten int chor, de frauen unde de junkfrauen an de luchter side besundergen, unde de mans unde knechte an de rechter side besundergen, unde de prester bereydet bröt unde wyn, unde wes darto nöt is.

When the preacher cometh down, a German psalm or song is sung; meanwhile the communicants go into the choir, the women and maidens on the left side apart, and the men and servants on the right side apart; and the priest prepareth bread and wine, and what is needful thereto.

Buxtehude sings all three stanzas of "Wir glauben" without the organ, because in it the church confesses its faith. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 75):

> Wen de predige geendiget, so schall der prediger upp dem predigstole dem chor und volke ahnheven Wy geloven. Unde dewile dat in dem Wy geloven de kercke ehren geloven bekennet, schollen alle dre versche ahne orgel van der gemeine ganz utgesungen werden. Dewile Wy geloven gesungen wert, schollen de communicanten in den chorr gahn, schicklick, ordentlick, mit reverentie dat hochwerdige sacramente aldar to entfangende.

When the sermon is ended, the preacher in the pulpit shall begin "We believe" for the choir and people. And because in "We believe" the church confesseth her faith, all three verses shall be sung wholly through by the congregation without organ. While "We believe" is being sung, the communicants shall go into the choir, seemly, orderly, with reverence, there to receive the most worthy sacrament.

**Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 460):

> Darna singet de Köster edder Scholemester mit synen Jüngern unde allem volcke, manne unde frouwen, de thom singende vormanet werden, den geloven. Unde darunder ghan de Communicanten ynt Chor.

Thereafter the sexton or schoolmaster, with his disciples and all the people, men and women, who are exhorted to sing, singeth the creed. And during it the communicants go into the choir.

**Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 224):

> Na dem sermone hevet de prester vor dem altare an: Credo in unum Deum. Darup gesungen: Wii geloven alle an einen Godt etc.

After the sermon the priest before the altar beginneth *Credo in unum Deum*. Thereupon is sung "We all believe in one God," etc.

The Lüneburg city order of 1575 keeps the organ silent during the creed. The creed also covers the minister's return to the altar. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 659):

> Es werden auch zu zeiten die leute vormhanet, das sie in der kirchen bey der communion pleiben, und wird darauf das: Wir gleuben gesungen und unter deme nicht uff der orgel geschlagen und darnegst nach gelegenheit derzeit das: Credo in unum Deum etc. Unter dem gehet der diener widderumb vor den altar.

The people are also at times exhorted to abide in the church for the communion; and thereupon "We believe" is sung, and during it the organ is not played; and next, according to the occasion of the time, the *Credo in unum Deum*, etc. During it the minister goeth again before the altar.

The Liegnitz order of 1542 also has the creed after the sermon, after the Lord's Prayer and the reading of 1 Corinthians 11. **Liegnitz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 3, p. 439):

> Darnach das evangelium teutsch und den gesang: Komm heiliger geist, und predigen drauf. Nach der predigt mag man singen das vater unser, nachdem mag man lesen den text Pauli 1. Cor. 11. Von dem abendmahl, oder das 6 te capitel Johannis. Darauf werde gesungen der glaube.

Thereafter the gospel in German, and the song "Come, Holy Ghost," and preach thereon. After the sermon one may sing the Our Father; after that one may read the text of Paul, 1 Corinthians 11, of the Supper, or the sixth chapter of John. Thereupon let the creed be sung.

#### 8.9.3 The creed-hymn to cover the preacher's movement

The creed often covered the preacher's going up into the pulpit or coming down to the altar. **Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Sehling 5, p. 468):

> Finito evangelio singe de magister mit dem chore: Wi geloven etc., underdes sticht de predicante up den predigstole.

When the gospel is finished, let the schoolmaster sing with the choir "We believe," etc.; meanwhile the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

In Württemberg the creed or a German psalm covered his coming down. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 107):

> In dem aber, so er herab steygt und die predig volendet hat, soll man den teutschen glauben oder ein teutschen Psalmen singen, bis der pfarrherr mit statten zu dem altar kompt, da man das nachtmal begeen will.

But while he cometh down, having ended the sermon, the German creed or a German psalm shall be sung, until the pastor is fully come to the altar where the Supper is to be kept.

#### 8.9.4 "Wir glauben" in the place of "Nun bitten"

At Schweinfurt "Nun bitten" followed the Latin *Patrem* on most Sundays. In Advent "Wir glauben all" was sung instead. **Schweinfurt, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576** (Sehling 11, p. 646):

> Chorus incipit Patrem, quo finito immediate sequitur cantio Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist. NB. Im Advent aber mus und sol anstatt des gesanges Nun bitten wir etc. das Wir glauben all an einen Gott etc. gesungen werden. NB. Per tres dominicas Adventus soll der glaub gesungen werden.

The choir beginneth the *Patrem*, which being ended there followeth straightway the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost." N.B.: But in Advent, in the stead of the song "Now pray we," etc., "We all believe in one God," etc. must and shall be sung. N.B.: Through three Sundays of Advent the creed shall be sung.

#### 8.9.5 How fixed the slot was

**Fixed.** The text was "Wir glauben all", with a sung Apostles' or Nicene Creed as the only alternative. It did not change with the season (Schweinfurt's Advent rule is an exchange between two fixed slots). Its place moved: after the gospel in the Saxon and southern orders, after the sermon in Bugenhagen's northern orders. After the sermon it served as the offertory while the communicants gathered.

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### 8.10 Before the sermon: "Nun bitten wir" and the old *Leisen*

The hymn before the sermon (*ante concionem*) is the second most fixed slot, after the creed. Its hymn is "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist". Its function is prayer. Many orders say the people shall "pray an Our Father, or sing" it, or sing it "an Gebets statt", "in the stead of prayer". The whole congregation asks for the Holy Ghost before the word is preached, and the preacher often intones it from the pulpit.

On the high feasts the orders put the old pre-Reformation *Leisen* in its place. These are single-stanza vernacular songs ending "Kyrieleis", in use before the Reformation and kept because the people knew them:

| Feast | *Leise* |
|---|---|
| Christmas | "Ein Kindelein so löbelich" (or "Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ") |
| Easter | "Christ ist erstanden" (or "Also heilig ist der Tag") |
| Ascension | "Christ fuhr gen Himmel" |
| Pentecost | "Nun bitten wir" itself, or "Komm heiliger Geist" |
| Trinity | "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" |

The pattern is **fixed, with seasonal exchange**. One hymn stands for most of the year and a *Leise* for each high feast and its season. Some orders use the Lord's Prayer hymn in Advent and Lent.

#### 8.10.1 "Nun bitten" as the prayer before the sermon

**Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1526** (Sehling 7/1, p. 70). This is the earliest seasonal table for the slot. The Ascension hymn is "Zu Himmel zu dem Vater mein", the ninth stanza of Luther's "Nun freut euch":

> und vor alle sinen predigen dat gebett Nun bidde wy denn hilligen Geist gesangeswyse bidden, utgenahmen, dat sick de gesang vor der predige na gelegenheit der tydt mut voranderen, alse in Winacht bet to lichtmissen: Gelavet sistu, Jesu Christ, van Pasten bet up de himmelfart Christi: Christ ist uperstanden, van der himmelfart bet to Pinxsten: To himmel to dem Vader myn, van Pinxsten wedder bet to Wynachten: Nun bidden wy den hilligen Geist.

and before all his sermons [the pastor shall] pray in the manner of a song the prayer "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; save that the song before the sermon must change according to the occasion of the season: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ"; from Easter unto the Ascension of Christ, "Christ is arisen"; from the Ascension unto Pentecost, "To heaven, to my Father"; from Pentecost again unto Christmas, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

The Naumburg order of 1527 sang the first stanza of "Nun bitten" with an added stanza of its own, "Herre Christ, Gottes Sohn". **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1527** (Sehling 2, p. 60):

> so ruft man den heiligen geist an mit disem gesange also: Nuhe bitten wir den heiligen geist, u.s.w. […] Herre Christ, gottes son, durch deiner marter willen, so bedenk aller christenheit not, denn du uns lieber herr an dem creuze hast erlost. Kirieleis. Hirnach so geht der prediger auf die canzel.

then the Holy Ghost is called upon with this song, thus: "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. […] "Lord Christ, Son of God, for thy passion's sake, remember the need of all Christendom; for thou, dear Lord, hast redeemed us on the cross. Kyrieleis." Hereafter the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 79), at the early sermon in Königsberg:

> und wird auf das gebet gesungen: Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist etc., damit gehet der pfarrherr auf die kanzel und predigt das evangelium de tempore.

and after the prayer is sung "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.; therewith the pastor goeth up into the pulpit and preacheth the gospel of the season.

In Nördlingen only the first stanza was sung, and the preacher began at once. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 312):

> Nach dem glauben sol aber die ganze kirche singen Nun bitten wir den Hailigen Gaist, nur das erste gesetze, und der predicant sol darauf predigen.

But after the creed the whole church shall sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," only the first stanza, and the preacher shall preach thereupon.

In Herford the preacher, from the pulpit, bade the people pray an Our Father or sing "Nun bitten", "according as the feasts are". **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 176):

> Den geit de Prediker up den predikestoel und vormanth, en Pater noster tho sprecken offt singen Nu bidde wy den Hilgen geist etc., nadem dat de feste sinth Paschen, Pinxsten, Winachten etc.

Then the preacher goeth up into the pulpit and exhorteth to say a *Pater noster*, or to sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc., according as the feasts are, Easter, Pentecost, Christmas, etc.

The Pfalz-Zweibrücken plan of 1565 has "Nun bitten" before the sermon every Sunday of the Trinity season, "one day as the other", and says so twice (Sehling 18, p. 340):

> Ante Concionem: Nun bitten wir etc. ain tag wie den andern. […] Nota: Unnd hernach allen Sontag vor der Predig bis Weinachten gesungen werden: Nun bitten wir etc.

Before the sermon: "Now pray we," etc., one day as the other. […] Note: and thereafter on every Sunday before the sermon, until Christmas, "Now pray we," etc. shall be sung.

For Christmas the same plan gives the *Leise* instead, until Candlemas, and then "Nun bitten" again until Easter (Sehling 18, p. 340):

> Also Mutatis Mutandis soll es an den nachvolgenden tagen gehalten, auch: Das kindelin, allemal vor der Predig gesungen werden bis Purificationis Marie, unnd hernach bis Ostern: Nun bitten wir etc.

So, *mutatis mutandis*, shall it be kept on the days following; also "The little Child" shall be sung always before the sermon until the Purification of Mary, and thereafter until Easter, "Now pray we," etc.

At Hof, on Good Friday, "Nun bitten" was dropped and the last stanza of the Passion hymn "Gott dem Vater sei Lob" was sung kneeling in its place. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 439):

> Loco Patrem: Got dem Vater sei lob und dem Sohn, ultimus versus hujus cantici genibus flexis canitur, loco Nun bitten wir. Nun bitten wir omittitur. Post concionem: O lamb Gottes unschuldig.

In the place of the *Patrem*: "To God the Father be praise, and to the Son"; the last verse of this song is sung on bended knees, in the place of "Now pray we." "Now pray we" is omitted. After the sermon: "O Lamb of God, innocent."

#### 8.10.2 The *Leisen* at the high feasts, sung from the pulpit

A family of orders runs from Mecklenburg (1552) through Lüneburg (1564) and Wolfenbüttel (1569) to Oldenburg (1573). In all of them the old German songs of the three feasts are sung by the preachers "from the pulpit, when they begin the sermon, with the people". **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 200):

> die deudschen alten liedlin, als uff Nativitatis Ein kindelein so löbelich, uff ostern Christ ist erstanden, item, Also heilig ist der tag, uff pfingsten Nu bitten wir etc. Und sollen auch diese die prediger von der canzel, wenn sie die predig anfahen, mit dem volk singen.

the old little German songs, as on the Nativity "A little Child so worthy of praise," at Easter "Christ is arisen," item "So holy is the day," at Pentecost "Now pray we," etc. And these also the preachers shall sing with the people from the pulpit, when they begin the sermon.

**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 545):

> Darauf sol man ein Vater unser sprechen oder singen: Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist. Umb die Weihnachten: Ein kindelein so löbelich etc. Umb die Ostern: Christ ist erstanden etc.

Thereupon one shall say an Our Father, or sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; about Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; about Easter, "Christ is arisen," etc.

The Lüneburg city order of 1575 calls these *Leisen* a "motet". **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 659):

> darnegst singt man das evangelion deutsch, darauf eine mutet, die heiligen Wiegenachten: Ein kindelein so lobelich, umb Osteren: Christ ist erstanden, auf himmelfart: Christ fur gen himmel, umb Pfingsten und sunsten das jhar durch: Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist.

next the gospel is sung in German; thereupon a "motet": at holy Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; about Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at the Ascension, "Christ went up to heaven"; about Pentecost and otherwise the year through, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

In Kurland the pastor intoned the *Leise* from the pulpit "after old custom". The list includes Simeon's song for the Purification. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 88):

> Und wenn die festtage verhanden, der lobgesang für der predigt auf der canzel nach alter gewonheit zu intonirn. Gelobet seistu, Jesu Christ. Ein kindelein, so löbelich. Herr nu lestu deinen diener. Christ ist erstanden. Christ fur zu himmel. Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist. Auf und nach pfingsten, so lang man wil. Auf trinitatis. Gott der vater wohne uns bei etc.

And when the feast days are at hand, the song of praise before the sermon is to be intoned in the pulpit after the old custom: "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ"; "A little Child so worthy of praise"; "Lord, now lettest thou thy servant"; "Christ is arisen"; "Christ went up to heaven"; "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," at and after Pentecost as long as one will; at Trinity, "God the Father be with us," etc.

Hoya had "Gelobet seist du" sung three times running at Christmas. For Trinity it had "O Vater unser, gnädiger Gott", which then served "the whole summer through". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1148–1149):

> Im anfang der predigt auf die hohen fest singet man auf dem predigstuel die alten, gewönlichen gesänge: auf Ostern Christ ist erstanden etc., auf Weynachten Gelobet seystu, Jhesu Christ etc. drey mal nacheinander, auf Pfingsten Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist mit den folgenden versen, am tage der heiligen dreyfaltigkeit O Vater unser, gne[…] diger Gott, sampt den zweyen folgenden versen. Und also gemelten gesang den ganzen sommer durch.

At the beginning of the sermon on the high feasts the old, accustomed songs are sung in the pulpit: at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc.; at Christmas "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc., three times one after another; at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" with the verses following; on the day of the Holy Trinity "O Father of ours, gracious God," together with the two verses following. And the said song so the whole summer through.

**Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 782):

> wan das aus ist, singet die ganze gemain: Wir glauben und darauf: Nun bitten wir den hailigen Gaist oder: Kom hailig Gaist, in Weyhnachten bis auf Lichtmes: Ein kindelein so löbelich, in Ostern bis auf Pfingsten: Christ ist erstanden, darauf volget die predige.

when that is out, the whole congregation singeth "We believe," and thereupon "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" or "Come, Holy Ghost"; at Christmas until Candlemas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter until Pentecost, "Christ is arisen"; thereupon followeth the sermon.

**Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 2, p. 133):

> Auf die hohen festa aber singt er von der canzel mit dem ganzen volk ein kurzes lied, welches uf solches fest verordnet ist, als uf weihnachten: Ein kindelein so löbelich, uf ostern: Christ ist erstanden, uf pfingsten: Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, uf trinitatis: Gott der vater wohn uns bei.

But on the high feasts he singeth from the pulpit with all the people a short song which is ordained for such feast: as at Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at Trinity, "God the Father be with us."

**Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560** (Sehling 19/1, p. 206):

> darauff so singet der Chor das: Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist, oder, so es an hohen Festen ist, derselbigen Deutschen gesang eines auff die Festa verordnet, als zu Weihenachten: Ein Kindelein so löbeleich, Zu Ostern: Christ ist erstanden etc. Auff das Gesang volget alßbaldt die Predigt.

thereupon the choir singeth "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; or, if it be on high feasts, one of the German songs of the same ordained for the feasts, as at Christmas "A little Child so worthy of praise," at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc. After the song the sermon followeth straightway.

Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order of 1528 already has "Christ ist erstanden" at the start of the Easter sermon, "after the accustomed manner", while "Christ lag" was farced into *Victimae* (§8.8.3). The Hamburg order of 1529 repeats the rule (§8.8.3).

The Hessian *Agende* (Philippist) gives the congregation's prayer before the sermon as the Lord's Prayer or a *Leise*. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 412):

> die ganze kirche eintrechtiglich singet das Vater unser oder einen andern gewönlichen gesang nach gelegenheit der zeit als: Ein kindelein so löbelich, Christ ist erstanden, Christ fuhr gen Himmel, Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist etc.

the whole church singeth with one accord the Our Father, or another accustomed song according to the occasion of the season, as: "A little Child so worthy of praise," "Christ is arisen," "Christ went up to heaven," "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

Verden's order has the preacher start the hymn himself and the congregation sing it to the end. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 156–157):

> Bißweilen mag er anstadt des Vater unsers den psalm Nu bitten wir den heiligen […] Geist anfangen und mit der gemeine zu end singen. Auf Weinachten soll man singen Ein kindelein so löbelich, auf Ostern Also heilig ist der tag oder Christ ist erstanden, auf himmelfahrt Christ fuhr gen himmel, auf Pfingsten Nu bitten wir den heiligen Geist, item Kom, heiliger Geist, Herre Gott, auf Trinitatis Gott der Vater wohne uns bey etc.

At times, in the stead of the Our Father, he may begin the psalm "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" and sing it to the end with the congregation. At Christmas one shall sing "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter "So holy is the day" or "Christ is arisen"; at the Ascension "Christ went up to heaven"; at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," item "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God"; at Trinity "God the Father be with us," etc.

### 8.10.3 Seasonal tables for the slot: the Lord's Prayer in Advent and Lent

Several orders give the whole year. In Lent (Lippe) or in Advent and Lent (Solms-Laubach) the Lord's Prayer hymn (Luther's "Vater unser im Himmelreich", or another Our Father song) takes the place of "Nun bitten". **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 387):

> so sol die Kirche ein Vater unser sprechen oder singen an Gebets statt die gewönlichen Gesenge nach gelegenheit der zeit und Festen, Als auff Ostern: Christ ist erstanden, bis auff Pfingsten. Von Pfingsten bis auff Weinachten: Nu bitten wir den Heiligen Geist. Auff Nativitatis Christi: Ein Kindelin so Löblich, bis an die Sontage der Fasten. Aber die Fasten uber sol das Vater unser oder sonst ein ander Bettpsalm gesungen werden.

then shall the church say an Our Father, or sing, in the stead of prayer, the accustomed songs according to the occasion of the season and feasts: as at Easter, "Christ is arisen," until Pentecost; from Pentecost until Christmas, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; at the Nativity of Christ, "A little Child so worthy of praise," until the Sundays of Lent. But through Lent the Our Father, or else another prayer-psalm, shall be sung.

**Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenordnung* [1576–1580]** (Sehling 9, pp. 359–360):

> und wirdt daruf die predigt angefangen und nach der praefation von weihnachten biß uf purificationis Mariae gesungen: Ein kindelein so löbelich etc., von purificationis biß uf ostern: Unser vatter, der du bist in dem hiemel, von ostern biß ascensionis: Christ ist erstanden, von ascensionis biß pfingsten: Christ fur ghen hiemel, von pfingsten biß uff den advent: […] Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, und: Gott, der vatter, wohn uns bei etc., vom advent biß uf weienachten: Unser vatter, der du bist in dem hiemel etc.

and thereupon the sermon is begun, and after the preface is sung, from Christmas until the Purification of Mary, "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; from the Purification until Easter, "Our Father, who art in heaven"; from Easter until the Ascension, "Christ is arisen"; from the Ascension until Pentecost, "Christ went up to heaven"; from Pentecost until Advent, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" and "God the Father be with us," etc.; from Advent until Christmas, "Our Father, who art in heaven," etc.

Tangermünde (1603) keeps the Christmas *Leise* on every Sunday until Candlemas. **Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603** (Sehling 3, p. 339):

> ante concionem canitur: Der Tag, der ist so freuden etc. vel alia festo conveniens. Praeterea ab hoc festo diebus solis usque ad festum purificationis ante concionem mediam canitur: Ein Kindelein so etc. vel alia de tempore.

before the sermon is sung "The day that is so full of joy," etc., or another agreeable to the feast. Moreover, from this feast on the Sundays until the feast of the Purification, before the midday sermon is sung "A little Child so," etc., or another of the season.

The Ysenburg-Birstein order uses the Lord's Prayer hymn from Trinity until Christmas. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 620):

> singet oder betet die Christliche Gemeyn mit ihme das Vatter unser oder anstat desselbigen einen kurtzen Gesang, der sich auff jede Jahrszeit schicket, als auff Weyhenachten: Ein Kindelein so löbelich etc., Auff Ostern: Christ ist erstanden etc., Auff Ascensionis Domini: Christ fuhr gen Himmel, Unnd auff Pfingsten: Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist etc.

the Christian congregation singeth or prayeth with him the Our Father, or instead of it a short song fitting every season of the year, as at Christmas "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc.; at Easter "Christ is arisen," etc.; at the Ascension of the Lord "Christ went up to heaven"; and at Pentecost "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.

**Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> und sprecken ein vader unse, effte singen den lavesank, kum hillige geist here godt etc. In den winachten ein kindelein so lavelick, in ostern Christ is upgestanden, in den pingsten nu bidde wi den hilgen geist.

and say an Our Father, or sing the song of praise "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc.; at Christmas, "A little Child so worthy of praise"; at Easter, "Christ is arisen"; at Pentecost, "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

**Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547**, German text (Sehling 24, p. 244):

> Nach diesem ampt helt man gmeiniklich in steten die erste predig, vor welcher allzeit etwas gesungen wirdt, als: Der tag, der ist so freudenreich, oder: Christ ist erstanden, oder: Vom Heiligen Geist, oder sonst ein psalmen, wie es die zeit des jars bringt. Nach der predig singt man abermals etwas nach der selbigen zeit oder umb frieden und desgleichen.

After this office the first sermon is commonly held in the towns, before which something is always sung, as "The day that is so full of joy," or "Christ is arisen," or "Of the Holy Ghost," or else a psalm, as the season of the year bringeth. After the sermon something is sung again after the same season, or for peace, and the like.

Waldeck sets the Lord's Prayer hymn, the Ten Commandments hymn, a seasonal German song and the creed before the chief sermon. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 273):

> Vor der Hohen Predigt sol der Pfarrherr, Custos und Gemeyn das Vatter unser Martini Lutheri: Vatter unser im hymelreich, der du uns alle etc., Darauff die Zehen Gebott, Eyn deutsch gesenge und Collecten auß Viti Theodori oder andern, nach gelegenheyt der zeit bewerdt, Volgents den Glauben singen.

Before the high sermon the pastor, sexton and congregation shall sing Martin Luther's Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven, who all of us," etc.; thereupon the Ten Commandments; a German song and collects out of Veit Dietrich or others, proved according to the occasion of the season; following, the creed.

#### 8.10.4 Chosen to fit the sermon

A few orders choose the hymn before the sermon by the sermon itself. At Thorn it was "a German song of the season, or what the text in hand and the common need required". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 237):

> wann der prediger auf die canzel steiget, soll anfänglich das volk zum gebet vermahnet ein deutsches lied de tempore oder was der furhabende text und gemeine noth gefordert, gesungen, auch ein vaterunser gebetet und folgends die predigt gefordert.

when the preacher goeth up into the pulpit, the people shall first be exhorted to prayer, and a German song of the season, or what the text in hand and the common need required, be sung, an Our Father also prayed, and following that the sermon set forward.

Brieg asks that the hymn "agree with the sermon as much as possible", but not at the cost of the songs the people already know. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

> Auf der canzel zum amt soll der pfarr die predigt mit einem christl. gesang und vater unser anfangen, es soll aber der gesang soviel möglich mit der predigt übereinstimmen und hiermit sollen andere christl. gute gesänge, welche dem gemeinen manne bekannt nicht unterworfen sein.

In the pulpit at the office the pastor shall begin the sermon with a Christian song and an Our Father; but the song shall agree with the sermon as much as possible; and hereby other good Christian songs which are known to the common man shall not be put under.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 gives a menu for this slot. "Nun bitten", "Wir glauben all" or the sung Apostles' Creed are the defaults. The last two stanzas of "Es ist das Heil" can be sung if its first stanzas were sung before the lesson. Several psalm-hymns can be chosen "if it may fit the following sermon". **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 653):

> für der predigt soll der schuelmeister singen: Nun bitten wir etc. oder: Wir glauben all etc. oder: Ich glaub an Gott etc. oder (da man für der lection gesungen: Es ist das heyl uns etc.) vollend die zwey letste geScätz desselben gesangs: Sey lob und ehr etc., oder (da es sich zue folgender predigt sclricken möchte): Herr Christ, der einig etc., Auß tieffer nott etc., Nun welche hie ir hoffnung etc. oder auß des Lobwaßers psalmenbuchlein den 33. Psalm biß auf den 7. versicul.

before the sermon the schoolmaster shall sing "Now pray we," etc., or "We all believe," etc., or "I believe in God," etc.; or (where "Salvation now is come to us," etc. was sung before the lesson) finish the two last stanzas of the same song, "Praise and honour," etc.; or (where it may fit the following sermon) "Lord Christ, the only," etc., "Out of the depths," etc., "Now they that here their hope," etc.; or out of Lobwasser's psalm book the thirty-third psalm, as far as the seventh verse.

#### 8.10.5 To cover the preacher's going up

As with the creed (§8.9.3), the hymn before the sermon often filled the time while the preacher climbed the pulpit. **Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 301):

> Uf dasselbig singt das volck ein theutschen psalmen oder zu einem vesttag ein theutsch lobgesang nach dem vest, darunder get der prediger uf die cantzel.

Thereupon the people sing a German psalm, or on a feast day a German song of praise after the feast; meanwhile the preacher goeth up into the pulpit.

**Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 659):

> so sing der schuelmaister den teutschen glauben oder Kum, Heiliger Geist; indem so ge der diener auf die cancel und postulir das evangelium.

then let the schoolmaster sing the German creed or "Come, Holy Ghost"; meanwhile let the minister go up into the pulpit and expound the gospel.

#### 8.10.6 How fixed the slot was

**Fixed, with seasonal exchange.** Outside the festal seasons the hymn was "Nun bitten wir", with "Komm heiliger Geist" or the Lord's Prayer hymn as the alternative. At the three (or four, or five) high feasts the old *Leise* of the feast took its place, often for the whole season to the next feast. Only a few late orders (Thorn 1575, Brieg 1592, Hohenlohe 1596) let the sermon decide the hymn in this slot.

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### 8.11 After the sermon: "Erhalt uns", the offertory, and the hymn that answers the sermon

The slot after the sermon (*post concionem*) did three jobs.

1. It was a prayer after the sermon, most often "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort". This was Luther's 1541/42 hymn "against the two arch-enemies of Christ and his holy Church, the Pope and the Turk", as the Pfalz-Zweibrücken songbook heads it.

2. It filled the old place of the offertory. The communicants came forward and the bread and wine were made ready while the people sang.
3. It covered the preacher's coming down from the pulpit, or his vesting for the altar.

Later orders added a fourth: to answer the sermon with a hymn on the same doctrine.

#### 8.11.1 "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort"

Prussia sang "Erhalt uns" after every sermon and gave the reason: to pray that God would not let his word be taken away. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 81):

> Wenn dieselbige aus ist, singet die ganze kirche wie nach aller predigt allezeit: Erhalt uns herr bei deinem wort etc., damit der fromme, treue gott demütig gebeten werde, dass er sein wort ja nicht lasse von uns genommen werden, sondern dasselbige wider allen widerstand aller rotten und tyrannen, die unter den namen des papstes und türken […].

When the same is out, the whole church singeth, as after every sermon always, "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., that the godly, faithful God may be humbly prayed that he suffer not his word to be taken from us, but [keep] the same against all resistance of all sects and tyrants, which under the names of the Pope and the Turk […].

In the Prussian villages the same hymn covered the priest's walk to the altar (Sehling 4, p. 84):

> Nach dem gebet singet die ganze kirche allezeit: Erhalt uns, herr, bei deinem wort etc., wie droben vermeldet ist. Unterdess gehet der priester von der kanzel fur den altar.

After the prayer the whole church singeth always "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., as is mentioned above. Meanwhile the priest goeth from the pulpit before the altar.

The Schweinfurt order of 1543 quotes the hymn's first lines, with the Pope and the Turk. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 641):

> Wenn nun die predig aus ist, sol man drauf singen: Behalt uns, Herre, bei deinem wort und steur des babsts und türken mord etc.

When now the sermon is out, one shall sing thereupon: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word, and curb the Pope's and Turk's murder," etc.

Schönburg sang it "when pressing need is at hand, as alas in these last times". **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

> Nach der predigt schlägt der organista etwas, bis der priester über den altar kommt, praeparavitque panem et calicem offerendum. Wenn aber anbeiende noth vorhanden, als leider zu diesen letzten zeiten, soll alle wege nach ausgang der predigt der schulmeister anheben zu singen mit der ganzen ecclesia: Erhalt uns herr bei deinem wort etc. Verleih uns frieden etc.

After the sermon the organist playeth somewhat, until the priest cometh to the altar and hath prepared the bread and the cup to be offered. But when pressing need is at hand, as alas in these last times, the schoolmaster shall always, at the end of the sermon, begin to sing with the whole church: "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc.; "Grant us peace," etc.

In Reuss the hymn after the sermon was always a song "for the common peace", begun from the pulpit. **Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 30 August 1552** (Sehling 2, pp. 153–154):

> Nach der predigt sol man allezeit uf der canzel einen gesang anfahen umb gemeinen friede, […] als: Erhalt uns herr bei deinem etc., Verlei uns frieden etc., O herr gott gib [uns dein fried].

After the sermon a song for the common peace shall always be begun in the pulpit, […] as: "Keep us, Lord, by thy," etc.; "Grant us peace," etc.; "O Lord God, give [us thy peace]."

**Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 558):

> Na der predige singet men: Erholt uns here bi dinem worde bet tom ende, edder ein andere dudeschen psalm David na gelegenheit der tidt sampt volgender collecta: Here godt, giff frede in dinem lande.

After the sermon is sung "Keep us, Lord, by thy word" to the end, or another German psalm of David according to the occasion of the season, with the collect following: "Lord God, give peace in thy land."

The Hoya order of 1581 (Sehling 6/2, p. 1149) and the Hildesheim chapter order of 1561 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 782; see §8.10.2) likewise set "Erhalt uns" after the sermon.

### 8.11.2 To cover the preacher's coming down, or his vesting

In Prussia (1544) the hymn after the sermon gave the priest time to come down from the pulpit, "take a little breath", and find his way back to the altar. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

> Bald auf die predigt, wo die litania nicht gehalten wird, singt die ganze kirche ein christlich lied, als: Nun freuet euch, lieben christen gemein. Nun lob mein seel den herren. Oder das vater unser von wort zu wort one auslegung nach der melodei des herren bischofs von Pomezan Doctoris Pauli Sperati. Unter des gehet der priester von der canzel, mag ein wenig respiriren und sich wieder zum altar finden.

Straightway after the sermon, where the litany is not held, the whole church singeth a Christian song, as "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," "Now praise, my soul, the Lord," or the Our Father word for word without exposition, after the melody of the lord bishop of Pomesania, Doctor Paul Speratus. Meanwhile the priest goeth from the pulpit, may take a little breath, and find himself again at the altar.

At Verden the preacher who was to celebrate put his vestments back on while the congregation sang out the hymn he had begun. **Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 157–158):

> Wenn nu die predigt geschlossen und das gemeine gebet verrichtet, so soll alßdan der prediger einen psalmen, als Gott der Vater wohn uns bey etc. oder Es wolt uns Gott gnädig sein, item Sey lob und ehr mit hohem preyß etc. oder nach ge[…]legenheit der zeit einen andern, auf der kanzel anfahen. Und soll derselbige von dem chor oder der gemeine vollends zu ende hinaus gesungen werden. Unterdessen aber soll der prediger, der das ambt halten und die communion verrichten wil, seinen ornatum ecclesiasticum wieder anlegen.

When now the sermon is ended and the common prayer performed, the preacher shall then begin in the pulpit a psalm, as "God the Father be with us," etc., or "May God be gracious unto us," item "Praise and honour with high price," etc., or another according to the occasion of the season. And the same shall be sung fully out to the end by the choir or the congregation. But meanwhile the preacher who will hold the office and perform the communion shall put on again his church vestment.

**Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 412). The Corvey order of 1603 copies it:

> Allhie gehet der pfarherr vom predigstuhl ab, und wird underdes der christlich lobgesang gesungen: Lobet den Herren, alle heiden etc., oder sonst ein anderer christlicher kurzer gesang, als: Gott der Vatter wohn uns bei, etc.

Here the pastor goeth down from the pulpit, and meanwhile the Christian song of praise is sung, "Praise the Lord, all ye heathen," etc., or else another short Christian song, as "God the Father be with us," etc.

**Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 659):

> so heb der schulmaister an zu singen ein kurzen psalm: Es woll uns Gott gnedig sein oder So pitten wir den Heiligen Gaist oder sünst, was ihm gefelt, das kurz ist. Indem so get der diener von der cancel zu dem altar.

then let the schoolmaster begin to sing a short psalm, "May God be gracious unto us," or "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or else what pleaseth him, that is short. Meanwhile the minister goeth from the pulpit to the altar.

**Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Sehling 5, p. 468):

> Im affstigende van dem predigstole singet de magister einen psalm.

In the coming down from the pulpit the schoolmaster singeth a psalm.

### 8.11.3 A hymn in the place of the offertory

The Latin offertory chant was a proper, and most orders dropped it because of its sacrificial texts. In many orders a German hymn took its place, sung while the bread and wine were prepared. Calenberg says so in the rubric of its printed Mass. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 814):

> Darnach gehet der priester wider vor den altar und singet der chor in mitteler zeit: Es wolt uns Gott gnedig sein etc. ader Gott der Vater wone uns bey etc. […] Darnach volget das offertorium. Anstat des offertorii sol man mit der gemein einen deutschen psalm singen.

Thereafter the priest goeth again before the altar, and the choir singeth in the meantime "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or "God the Father be with us," etc. […] Thereafter followeth the offertory. In the stead of the offertory a German psalm shall be sung with the congregation.

The same order's German Christmas Mass names the hymn (Sehling 6/2, p. 821):

> Offertorium. Anstat des offertorii singe man Ein kindelein so löbelich etc.

Offertory. In the stead of the offertory let "A little Child so worthy of praise," etc. be sung.

The rubric in the general part of the order gives the reason: the priest must make himself ready and prepare everything for the communion (Sehling 6/2, p. 795):

> Und weil er sich da zur communion geschickt machen und alles bereiten mus, sol in mitler zeit die gemein einen feinen deutschen psalm singen.

And because he must there make himself ready for the communion and prepare all things, the congregation shall meanwhile sing a fine German psalm.

**Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554** (Sehling 21, p. 209):

> Na der predeke mach men echter einen bequemen Lavesang vor dat Offertorium singen.

After the sermon one may again sing a fitting song of praise for the offertory.

**Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538]** (Sehling 22, p. 568):

> Dat offertorium Vor dat offertorium synget me eyn geystlick leidt, dat ys eyn psalme.

The offertory. For the offertory a spiritual song is sung, that is, a psalm.

The Naumburg order of 1527 sang "Aus tiefer Not" in the place of the offertory. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1527** (Sehling 2, p. 60):

> so hebt man an in stat des offertoriumbs zu singen durch die ganze kirche den vordeutschten psalm Davids de profundis clamavi ad te etc. also wie folget: Aus tiefer not schrei ich zu dir.

then one beginneth, in the stead of the offertory, to sing through the whole church the psalm of David put into German, *De profundis clamavi ad te*, etc., as followeth: "Out of the depths I cry to thee."

The Brandenburg order of 1540 kept the Latin offertory of the day in the collegiate churches and let the villages sing a German psalm instead. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 71):

> und nach geendigter predig das offertorium von der dominica oder festen, aber auf den dörfern mag man dafur einen deudschen psalmen singen.

and after the sermon is ended, the offertory of the Sunday or feast; but in the villages one may sing a German psalm for it.

In Corvinus's Lippe order the people sang Psalm 67 or "Dank sagen wir alle" while the priest made ready the wine and bread. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus [1542]** (Sehling 21, p. 345):

> Na gheschener bicht synget dat volck: Edt wolde uns Godt gnedich syn edder: Danck segge wy alle etc., mydtler tydt beredet de prester wyn und brodt vor de communicanten.

After the confession is done, the people sing "May God be gracious unto us," or "Thanks say we all," etc.; meanwhile the priest maketh ready wine and bread for the communicants.

In the Lutheran East Frisian liturgy of Engerhafe, organ and congregation sang "Herr Christ, der einig Gottessohn" in alternation while the communicants came to the table. **Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583** (Sehling 7/1, p. 677):

> Deinde pastor accedat ad mensam Domini, paret panem et infundat vinum in calicem. Organicen vero et ecclesia alternis canant hymnum Herr Christ, der einig Gottessohn, et interim communicantes ad mensam convenire poterunt.

Thereafter let the pastor go to the table of the Lord, prepare the bread and pour the wine into the cup. But let the organist and the church sing by turns the hymn "Lord Christ, the only Son of God," and meanwhile the communicants may come together to the table.

The Albertine order for Celle kept Latin here, with the people kneeling in prayer "in the stead of the offertory". **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 300):

> Man möchte auch wol zu zeiten abwechseln und einen andern reinen lateinischen gesang dafur singen, under disem obgeschribenen gesange sal das volk nider knien und sein gebete thuen an stadt des offertorii.

One might also at times change about and sing another pure Latin song for it. During this song written above the people shall kneel down and make their prayers in the stead of the offertory.

#### 8.11.4 While the communicants come forward

Many orders tie the hymn to the movement of the communicants into the choir. It is sung "until they all kneel". **Anhalt, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Princes Johann and Georg, 3 August 1548** (Sehling 2, p. 554):

> Nach der prediget weil die communicanten in den chor gehen, die menner zur rechten, die weiber zur linken hand, soll ein deutscher psalm gesungen werden, bis das sie al[le knien].

After the sermon, while the communicants go into the choir, the men to the right, the women to the left hand, a German psalm shall be sung until they all [kneel].

**Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 22, p. 450):

> so lange die preedike geendigt ys, alßden werdt men enen karten Psalm singen, midtler tidt gaen se ynt kor, setten sick dale up eer knee.

until the sermon is ended; then a short psalm shall be sung; meanwhile they go into the choir and set themselves down upon their knees.

**Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 312):

> Nach der predig sol der chor singen ein teusch lidlein, bis der celebrant zum communicieren den kelch und die ostien zubereitet, und die communicanten sollen sich für den alter fünden.

After the sermon the choir shall sing a little German song, until the celebrant hath prepared the cup and the hosts for communicating; and the communicants shall find themselves before the altar.

Pomerania (1535) used the Ten Commandments hymn or *Da pacem*. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

> Wenn dat alle ute is, so singet men van den tein baden gades eder da pacem latinisch unde düdesch, eder sus wat anders. Under des vögen sick de communicanten to dem altar de manns up de rechte hand de frouwen up de luchtere hande.

When all that is out, one singeth of the ten commandments of God, or *Da pacem* in Latin and German, or else somewhat other. Meanwhile the communicants betake themselves to the altar, the men on the right hand, the women on the left.

Brieg asked that this hymn, too, agree with the sermon. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 446):

> Nach der predigt soll der cantor einen deutschen gesang singen, damit sich die communicanten können zum altar finden; es soll aber auch der gesang mit der predigt übereinstimmen.

After the sermon the cantor shall sing a German song, that the communicants may find their way to the altar; but the song also shall agree with the sermon.

#### 8.11.5 A hymn to answer the sermon

The Mecklenburg order of 1545 wanted a short hymn after the sermon, "commonly a prayer, which the whole congregation can sing". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

> schal de pastor na dem gespraken bede, einen psalm anfangen, de nicht lank is, gemenlich ein gebet, den de ganze gemene singen kann, alse: Idt wolde uns godt gnedich sin, Here Christ etc. Wat kan uns kamen an vor not.

the pastor shall, after the prayer spoken, begin a psalm that is not long, commonly a prayer, which the whole congregation can sing, as: "May God be gracious unto us," "Lord Christ," etc., "What need can come upon us."

Later orders ask that it agree with the sermon's teaching. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

> Nach der predigt und dem gebet sol der pastor einen psalm anfahen, der mit der lere des evangelii sol übereinstimmen.

After the sermon and the prayer the pastor shall begin a psalm which shall agree with the teaching of the gospel.

The Hanau-Lichtenberg order gives examples by Sunday. **Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 20/2, p. 54):

> III. Die Predig sol alwegen mit eim Gesang, so mit uberein stimmet und sich darzu reimet, beschlossen werden, Als auff Misericordias Domini singt man: Auß tieffer not, Auff Jubilate: Ach Gott, vom Himel sihe darein, Auf Cantate: Ein feste Burg, Auff Trinitatis: Gott, der Vater, wohn uns bey etc.

III. The sermon shall always be concluded with a song which agreeth and rhymeth therewith: as on Misericordias Domini one singeth "Out of the depths"; on Jubilate, "Ah God, from heaven look down"; on Cantate, "A mighty fortress"; on Trinity, "God the Father be with us," etc.

In Marienhafe the hymn after the blessing was one "agreeing with the sermon". **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 697):

> volgens der segen gesprochen und darauf ein psalm oder leid, auf der predigt stimmend, myt denn orgel ahnfangen und von chor und gemeine außgesungen etc.

following that the blessing spoken, and thereupon a psalm or song agreeing with the sermon, begun with the organ and sung out by choir and congregation, etc.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 has the schoolmaster ready with a hymn chosen by the doctrinal article the sermon chiefly treated. It gives twelve articles, each with its hymns. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 653):

> Sontags wie auch an gemeinen feyertagen nach der predigt solle der schuelmaister widerumb mit einem gesang gefast sein, als, da die predigt fürnemblich were gerichtet gewesen auf den articul 1. Vom wort und sacramenten: Der IJerr ist mein getreuer hiert etc., 0 Gott, du liöchster gnadenhort etc., Gott, der Vatter etc., auß dem Lobwaßer den 93. Psalm: Gott als ein könig etc. 2. Vom gesatz und guetten werken: IJerr Christ, der einig Gottes etc., 0 Gott, du höchster etc., Nun bitten.

On Sundays, as also on common holy days, after the sermon the schoolmaster shall again be provided with a song: as, when the sermon had been directed chiefly to the article (1) of the word and sacraments, "The Lord is my faithful shepherd," etc., "O God, thou highest treasury of grace," etc., "God the Father," etc., out of Lobwasser the ninety-third psalm, "God as a king," etc.; (2) of the law and good works, "Lord Christ, the only [Son] of God," etc., "O God, thou highest," etc., "Now pray we."

The list goes on through the articles on the gospel, sin and the merit of Christ, prayer, the cross, persecution, earthly want and blessing, the transience of life, the pestilence, idolatry, and the last day. When many communicants were waiting, a short hymn was to be sung instead (Sehling 15, p. 654):

> Im fall aber am sontag vill communicanten fürhanden weren, alßdan umb der kurtze willen: Danksagen wir alle etc. oder auß Lobwaßer den 93. Psalm: Gott als ein könig etc., den 100.: Ihr völker auf der erden all etc. oder den 117.: Den Herrn lobt ihr etc. oder den 121.: Mein augen ich etc.

But in case there were many communicants on the Sunday, then for brevity's sake: "Thanks say we all," etc., or out of Lobwasser the ninety-third psalm, "God as a king," etc., the hundredth, "Ye peoples on the earth all," etc., or the hundred and seventeenth, "Praise ye the Lord," etc., or the hundred and twenty-first, "Mine eyes I," etc.

Reutlingen wanted variety here. It asked for "not always the old common fiddle", "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein", even though that too was a fine psalm. **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 49):

> Nach der predig, so man communiciern will, sollen sie singen: Ehre sey dem vatter etc., oder: Sey lob und eher mit hohem preyß etc., unnd wa man nit communiciert, abermals ainen schönen psalmen und nit nur alwegen die alte, gemaine geigen: Es wölle uns Gott gegnädig sein, welcher schöner, herrlicher psalm doch auch nit underlassen, sonder beyweilen wie andere gesungen werden soll.

After the sermon, when there is to be communion, they shall sing "Glory be to the Father," etc., or "Praise and honour with high price," etc.; and where there is no communion, again a fair psalm, and not only always the old common fiddle, "May God be gracious unto us"; which fair, glorious psalm yet shall not be left off, but be sung at times like the others.

The Reutlingen school visitation of 1574 asked for a hymn "agreeable to the season or to the text preached", and not a weary repetition of the one sung before the sermon. **Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574** (Sehling 17/2, p. 58):

> Item, es solle allwegen nach der predig, sonderlich wann man das heilig nachtmal nit heltt, ein sonder gesang oder psalm ohngevar uff drey oder vier gesetz, minder oder mehr, der zeitt oder dem gepredigten text gemes, gesungen unnd der vor der predig gesungne (ohngeacht, das er nit gar zu endt gebracht) nit mit vertruß (wie bißanhero vilfelttig beschehen) widerholt werden.

Item, there shall always after the sermon, especially when the holy Supper is not held, be sung a separate song or psalm of about three or four stanzas, less or more, agreeable to the season or to the text preached; and the one sung before the sermon (notwithstanding that it was not brought quite to the end) shall not be repeated to weariness, as hath hitherto often been done.

#### 8.11.6 One hymn split around the sermon

Some orders split a single hymn: the first stanzas before the sermon and the rest after it. The Naumburg order does this with the Lord's Prayer hymn. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

> Darauf ein kurzer psalm nach der zeit, oder Vorleih uns frieden gnediglich, Es wolt uns got gnedig sein, Die lezten drei gesetz, im Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, Und die andern hohen fest de tempore, item Behalt uns herr bei deinem wort, Die lezten sechs gesez im vater unser, so man vor der predigt die ersten drei gesungen hat.

Thereupon a short psalm according to the season; or "Grant us peace graciously," "May God be gracious unto us," the last three stanzas of "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," and on the other high feasts of the season, item "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," the last six stanzas of the Our Father, when the first three have been sung before the sermon.

**Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 8 February 1551** (Sehling 2, p. 556), for Christmas:

> Am christag und ezliche tage darnach singe man vor der fruepredig drei versen von dem lobsang: Gelobet seistu Jesu Christ etc. und die ander versen nach der predig, in der messen vor dem evangelio singe man: Gelobet seistu Jesu Christ gar aus.

On Christmas Day and some days after, let three verses of the song of praise "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," etc. be sung before the early sermon, and the other verses after the sermon; in the Mass before the gospel let "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ" be sung through entire.

The German school order of Öhringen had the schoolmaster sing, after the sermon, the last stanza of the hymn he had sung before it. **Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582** (Sehling 15, p. 503):

> soll er ein psalmen singen, als: O Here Gott begnade mich etc. oder: Eß ist das heil uns kommen her etc. und dergleichen. […] Nach der predigt das letzt gesang des vorigen psalmen als: Sey lob und ehr mit hohem preiß oder dergleichen etwas kurztes.

he shall sing a psalm, as "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," etc., or "Salvation now is come to us," etc., and the like. […] After the sermon the last stanza of the foregoing psalm, as "Praise and honour with high price," or the like, somewhat short.

At Neuenrade, in Holy Week, the Passion hymn "Gott dem Vater sei Lob" was sung to its fifteenth stanza before the sermon and taken up again there after it (Sehling 22, p. 531). The funeral orders of Schwäbisch Hall and Limpurg split the burial hymn in the same way (§8.17.4).

#### 8.11.7 How fixed the slot was

**A handful, with a trend toward the variable.** The Saxon, Prussian and northern orders mostly fixed the slot on "Erhalt uns", with "Verleih uns Frieden", "Es woll uns Gott" or "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" as the alternatives. Where it was the offertory, any "German psalm" would do. From the 1560s the Upper German, Hessian (Moderate Reformed), Hohenlohe and East Frisian orders increasingly wanted a hymn chosen to answer the sermon. That is the most topical choice of hymn anywhere in the service.

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## 8.12 The Sanctus: "Jesaia dem Propheten" and "Heilig ist Gott der Vater"

The German Sanctus had two forms:

- Luther's "Jesaia dem Propheten das geschah" (1526). This is a rhymed narrative of Isaiah 6, printed in the *Deutsche Messe*.
- A troped Trinitarian Sanctus, "Heilig ist Gott der Vater, heilig ist Gott der Sohn, heilig ist Gott der Heilige Geist", printed in Low German in Bugenhagen's Wolfenbüttel order.

The Latin Sanctus stayed in towns with schools and on feasts. In most orders the German Sanctus followed the sermon and exhortation and led straight into the communion. In some it was sung during the distribution itself (§8.14).

#### 8.12.1 "Jesaia dem Propheten" as the communicants come forward

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 65):

> Darauf singt der chor ader die kirche das deudsche sanctus oder das lied: Jesaia dem propheten das geschach, dar unter bald treten zum altar die communiciren wöllen, und darf der priester das sacrament nicht erheben, dann die elevation ist disfals unnötig, und aus dieser ursach abgethan.

Thereupon the choir or the church singeth the German Sanctus, or the song "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," during which those that will communicate straightway step to the altar. And the priest need not elevate the sacrament, for the elevation is herein unneedful, and for this cause is done away.

**Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 319):

> Das Sanctus aus dem Esaia teutsch, damit sich das volk zur communion im chor samele.

The Sanctus out of Isaiah in German, that the people may gather in the choir for the communion.

Pomerania had the boys intone the words "Heilig ist Gott der Herre Zebaoth" inside Luther's hymn, with the choir answering. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 438):

> De pastor schal ock vorschaffen, dat vor dat sanctus vaken gesungen werde: Esaia dem propheten dat geschach etc. unde dat de knaben allene dat sanctus darinne intoneren unde dat chor respondere.

The pastor shall also see to it that in the stead of the Sanctus there be often sung "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," etc., and that the boys alone intone the Sanctus therein and the choir answer.

Wittgenstein gives "Dank sagen wir alle" as an alternative in this slot. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 103):

> Nach verrichter predige fange man den lobgesang an zusingen: Esaia, dem propheten, das geschach etc., oder: Danck sagen wir alle etc.

After the sermon is performed, let the song of praise be begun: "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," etc., or "Thanks say we all," etc.

The later Kurpfalz text of 1577 gives the choice between "das sanctus, Isaia dem propheten, Grates nunc omnes, danck sagen wir alle oder einen andern dergleichen kurtzen gesang" (Sehling 14, p. 149, apparatus).

In Calenberg's German Masses the priest prayed a collect for the authorities in silence while the Sanctus hymn was sung. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542**, the German Christmas Mass (Sehling 6/2, p. 821):

> Hirauf folget das Sanctus. Jesaia dem propheten .... Die collecta, so der priester unter dem Sanctus betet. Barmherziger himlischer Vater.

Hereupon followeth the Sanctus, "Isaiah the prophet ...". The collect which the priest prayeth during the Sanctus: "Merciful heavenly Father ..."

#### 8.12.2 The Trinitarian German Sanctus

**Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 59):

> Up de latinische praefatio mach de ganze kercke frölick dat düdesch Sanctus singen. (Noten:) Hillich is Got, de Vader, hillich is Got, de Sone, hillich is Got, de hilge Geist. He is de Here Zebaoth. Alle werld is syner ehren vul. Hosianna in der höchde. Gelavet sy, de dar kumpt im namen des Heren. Hosianna in der höchde. (Ende der Noten). Sülck düdesch Sanctus mach men wol ock up ein andermal edder alle tidt singen under der communion neven andern gesengen.

After the Latin preface the whole church may joyfully sing the German Sanctus. (Notes:) "Holy is God the Father, holy is God the Son, holy is God the Holy Ghost. He is the Lord of Sabaoth. All the world is full of his glory. Hosanna in the highest. Blessed be he that cometh in the name of the Lord. Hosanna in the highest." (End of notes.) Such German Sanctus may well be sung another time also, or at all times, during the communion alongside other songs.

Stralsund kept the Latin Sanctus for feasts and the two German forms for the rest of the year. **Stralsund, draft *Kirchenordnung*, 1555** (Sehling 4, p. 551):

> Up de feste Sanctus agnus dei underwilen gesungen, und up de andern tide dudesk: Hilich is godt de vader, und wo idt ock doctor Martinus ut deme propheten Esaia vordudeschet hefft.

On the feasts the Sanctus and Agnus Dei are sung at times; and at the other times in German, "Holy is God the Father," and as Doctor Martin hath also put it into German out of the prophet Isaiah.

Mecklenburg allowed the towns to take the Sanctus melodies set in the songbooks for the feasts, matched to their Kyries. The villages sang "Jesaia" or "Heilig ist Gott der Vater". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 154):

> Na der prefation singet men in den steden dat sanctus latine, to tiden Esaia dem propheten. Idt is ock nicht not, dat me stedes ein sanctus to latine singe, sünder de sülven to tiden nemen, de in den sankböken van den groten festen up de kyrie vorordent sint. Up den dörperen singe men dat Esaia, edder dat ander: Hillich is godt de vader, welck me in den steden ock to tiden singen mach.

After the preface one singeth in the towns the Sanctus in Latin, at times "Isaiah the prophet." Neither is it needful always to sing one Sanctus in Latin; but at times take those which in the songbooks of the great feasts are appointed to the Kyries. In the villages let "Isaiah" be sung, or the other, "Holy is God the Father," which may also be sung at times in the towns.

In Harlingerland three boys knelt to sing the Benedictus. The *Et homo factus est* of the creed was sung the same way. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 738):

> vor der communion ordnen wir zu singende daß Sanctus latein und teutsch, alß solches in bemeltem psalmbock Lutheri zue finden, und daß mit sonderlicher andacht, durch drey knaben niedergekniet, daß Benedictus und in dem Symbolo Athanasii Et homo factus est gesxungen werden soll, alß den solcheß biß daher gebreuchlich gewesen.

Before the communion we ordain to be sung the Sanctus in Latin and German, as the same is to be found in the said psalm book of Luther; and that with special devotion, by three boys kneeling, the Benedictus, and in the creed the *Et homo factus est*, shall be sung, as the same hath hitherto been customary.

#### 8.12.3 At the elevation

Brandenburg kept the elevation. After it the collegiate churches sang the Latin responsory *Tua est potentia* and the parishes a German hymn. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 69):

> Nach der elevation sol man in Thumen und stiften einen latinischen gesang singen, als das responsorium tua est potencia etc., in den pfarren aber einen deudschen gesang. Es wolt uns gott gnedig sein oder sei lob und dank mit hohem preis.

After the elevation one shall sing in cathedrals and collegiate churches a Latin song, as the responsory *Tua est potentia*, etc.; but in the parishes a German song, "May God be gracious unto us," or "Praise and thanks with high price."

The bells rung at the elevation are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.4.

#### 8.12.4 In the place of Sanctus and Agnus

Hof allowed "Jesaia" in the place of the Latin Sanctus and Agnus, or after them when there were many communicants. At Christmas it used "Vom Himmel hoch". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

> Interdum loco Sanctus et Agnus (vel etiam praesentibus multis, qui participant de corpore et sanguire Christi, post illa) canitur: Esaia, dem propheten, das ge[schach].

Sometimes in the place of the Sanctus and Agnus (or also, when many are present who partake of the body and blood of Christ, after them) is sung "Isaiah the prophet, it befell."

#### 8.12.5 How fixed the slot was

**Fixed.** The choice was between the Latin Sanctus (graded, on feasts), Luther's "Jesaia", and the Trinitarian "Heilig ist Gott der Vater". Rarely a hymn of thanks ("Dank sagen wir alle", *Grates nunc omnes*) or a hymn of prayer at the elevation takes its place.

### 8.13 The Lord's Prayer and the Words of Institution

No troped or farced Paternoster or Words of Institution were found in the corpus. The Verba were sung by the priest to Luther's tones, or read. The Lord's Prayer was often sung by the priest in German, and sometimes by the whole congregation as Luther's metrical "Vater unser im Himmelreich".

#### 8.13.1 The congregation sings the Lord's Prayer hymn

In the Braunschweig villages the sexton and people sang Luther's "Vaterunser" after the epistle, and the pastor sang the Lord's Prayer and the Verba before the communion (§8.3.3). In Schwarzburg the people sang the Lord's Prayer themselves where there were no scholars. **Schwarzburg and Stolberg, *Ordenunge der religion*, 1549** (Sehling 2, p. 130):

> Wan nicht schuler sein, mach das valch selbs singen das vater unser, darnach geschicht di communio des volk etc. — Mach das volk singen: Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeit. Ader ander schone gesang.

Where there are no scholars, the people may themselves sing the Our Father; thereafter the communion of the people taketh place, etc. The people may sing "God be praised and blessed," or other fair songs.

At weekday communions in Riga the whole assembly sang the Lord's Prayer hymn, so that the schoolboys were not kept from their lessons. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

> Am wercktag aber, so die communicanten verhanden sind, singt man vor der predigt, wie gewonlich, aber bald nach der predigt, hebt man an das gesetzte lied des vater unsers, das es die ganze versammlung singe (da mit die knaben in der schulen an irer lere nicht verhindert werden). Darauf spricht der priester die wort der benedeiung über das brot, über den wein.

But on the working day, when communicants are present, one singeth before the sermon as is customary; but straightway after the sermon one beginneth the set song of the Our Father, that the whole assembly may sing it (that the boys in the school be not hindered in their learning). Thereupon the priest speaketh the words of blessing over the bread and over the wine.

**Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590** (Sehling 19/1, p. 407):

> Hernach sprech oder sing der Priester das Vatter unser und die Wort vom Leib und Blut Christi oder mag die Kirch das Vatter unser Teutsch miteinander singen.

Thereafter let the priest say or sing the Our Father and the words of the body and blood of Christ; or the church may sing the Our Father in German together.

#### 8.13.2 A communion hymn split around the consecration

A Henneberg village pastor began Hus's "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" before the Lord's Prayer and the Verba, and had the people finish it during the distribution. **Queienfeld (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 344):

> Nach der predigt, wen communicanten do sein, singen wir: Jesus Christus unser heiland etc. Darauf singe ich oder lese das vater unser. Darnach verba consecrationis. Darnach communicir ich die leut und das volk singt das: Jesus Christus vollend aus und: Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet etc.

After the sermon, when there are communicants, we sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc. Thereupon I sing or read the Our Father. Thereafter the words of consecration. Thereafter I communicate the people, and the people sing "Jesus Christ" out to the end, and "God be praised and blessed," etc.

In the Lutheran liturgy of Engerhafe the three stanzas of "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" were divided across the rite. The first came after the Verba, the second after the exhortation, and the third after the absolution, and with the third the communion began. **Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 678–680):

> Canatur Imo O lamm Gottes unschuldig etc.

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the first time.

> Canatur 2do O lamm Gottes unschuldig etc. et dicat sacerdos: Kniet nieder, geliebte im Herrn, erhebet eure herzen zu Gott und lasset uns andächtig beten.

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the second time, and let the priest say: "Kneel down, beloved in the Lord, lift up your hearts to God, and let us pray devoutly."

> Canatur 3tio O lamm Gottes unschuldig etc. et fiat communicatio his verbis.

Let "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc. be sung the third time, and let the communion be made with these words.

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### 8.14 Under the communion (*sub communione*)

Hymns during the distribution are named more often than hymns in any other slot. The core never changed through the century:

- **"Jesus Christus unser Heiland, der von uns den Gotteszorn wandt"**, Luther's version of the Latin hymn ascribed to John Hus, and often called "Johann Hussen Lied";
- **"Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet"**, Luther's expansion of a medieval single stanza;
- **the German Sanctus**, "Jesaia dem Propheten";
- **Psalm 111** in German, "Ich danke dem Herrn von ganzem Herzen" (Luther's *Confitebor*);
- **the Agnus Dei**, Latin or German ("O Lamm Gottes unschuldig", "Christe, du Lamm Gottes").

Around this core stood hymns added "when there are many communicants". These were the Latin responsory *Discubuit Jesus*, *O sacrum convivium*, *Pange lingua* (in Latin and German, "Mein Zung erkling"), "Als Jesus Christus unser Herr" (Sebald Heyden), "Nun freut euch", "Was kann uns kommen an für Not", "O Christ, wir danken deiner Güt", "Help Gott, dass mir's gelinge", a Passion hymn in Lent, the festal hymns at the feasts, and the German Te Deum.

#### 8.14.1 The core pair

**Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 33):

> Under solchem communicirn sol das volk mit dem chor singen das deütsch lied Jesus Christus unser heilaut, und nach der communication got sei gelobet etc.

During such communicating the people with the choir shall sing the German song "Jesus Christ our Saviour," and after the communion "God be praised," etc.

**Eisfeld, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 562):

> Unter der communion sol man singen das lid Joannis Hussen: Jesus Christus unser heiland, oder got sei gelobet oder Christe du lamb gott[es].

During the communion the song of John Hus shall be sung, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "God be praised," or "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

A Henneberg pastor calls Hus's hymn "the instructive and comforting song of the holy martyr John Hus". **Herpf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 335):

> Unter dieser und der allerheiligsten action singt der chor das lerhaftig und trostlich lied des heiligen merterers Johannis Huss Jesus Christus unser heiland etc. und darauf die danks[agung Gott sei gelobet].

During this and the most holy action the choir singeth the instructive and comforting song of the holy martyr John Hus, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., and thereupon the thanksgiving, "God be praised."

Bremen in 1561 wanted Hus's hymn "in the ancient melody", that is, the Latin *Jesus Christus nostra salus*, "and at times also in the new one composed by Luther". This order was written against the Zwinglian party in Bremen, and it sets out the communion hymns in order. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 510):

> Placet igitur nobis, ut occinatur textus Esaiae alternis vicibus Latine vel Germanice. Hunc postea sequatur inter communicandum cantilena Johannis Huß in prisca melodia et interdum etiam in recenti per Lutherum composita. Adiiciatur quoque psalmus 111 una cum Agnus Dei, si magna est multitudo communicantium. Et tandem concludatur cum gratiarum actione: Gott sey gelobt etc.

It pleaseth us therefore that the text of Isaiah be sung, by turns in Latin or German. Let there follow it, during the communicating, the song of John Hus in the ancient melody, and at times also in the new one composed by Luther. Let there be added also the hundred and eleventh psalm together with the Agnus Dei, if the multitude of communicants be great. And at length let it be concluded with the thanksgiving "God be praised," etc.

#### 8.14.2 As many hymns as there are communicants

Nearly every order measures the number of communion hymns by the number of communicants. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 369):

> Unter der communion, und so der communicanten viel sind, sol das agnus dei lateinisch, sampt den deudschen gesengen, als Esaia dem propheten das geschach, item der 111. psalm, ich danke dem herrn von ganzem herzen, oder, Jesus Christus unser heiland, item, gott sei gelobet, etc. eins oder mehr gesungen werden.

During the communion, and when the communicants are many, the Agnus Dei in Latin, together with the German songs, as "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," item the hundred and eleventh psalm, "I thank the Lord with all my heart," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," item "God be praised," etc., one or more, shall be sung.

**Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 309):

> Unter der communion sol man singen: Jesus Christus unser heiland, item, Gott sei gelobet, oder, Esaia dem propheten das geschach, oder was sonsten von geistlichen gesengen sein mag, so dieser action gemess und bequem und die notdurft nach anzal der communicanten erfordert. Wann aber der communicanten so wenig, das auch obgemelter gesenge einer zu lang were, so sol darmit, so bald die communion geendet, auch aufgehört werden.

During the communion shall be sung "Jesus Christ our Saviour," item "God be praised," or "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," or what else there may be of spiritual songs which are agreeable and fitting to this action and which the need requireth according to the number of communicants. But when the communicants are so few that even one of the aforesaid songs were too long, then it shall be stopped as soon as the communion is ended.

At the Dresden Kreuzkirche all the listed hymns were sung if there were many communicants. **Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574** (Sehling 1, p. 555):

> sub communione canitur vel agnus dei, sanctus, Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet, Jesus Christus unser heiland, mein zung erkling. Si multi sunt communicantes omnes hae cantilenae canuntur.

During the communion is sung either the Agnus Dei, the Sanctus, "God be praised and blessed," "Jesus Christ our Saviour," "My tongue, resound." If the communicants are many, all these songs are sung.

The Lippe order puts the Agnus Dei, "O Lamm Gottes" and "O Christ, wir danken deiner Güt" on the high feasts, and ends with a hymn of thanks. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 388):

> Unter der Communion, weil das Sacrament dispensirt und ausgetheilet wirdt, soll die Kirche der Nachgesetzten Gesenge einen oder mehr, darnach der Communicanten viel oder wenig, singen, als: Jhesus Christus, unser Heylandt; Auff den Hohen Festagen: Agnus Dei, O Lamb Gottes, unschüldig, O Christ, wir dancken deiner güte. Nach der Communion sol vom Predicanten die Collecta gesungen, darauff die gewönliche segen oder Benedictio, Nume. 6, gegen dem Volcke gesprochen werden, Und entlich mit einem Danckliede Als: Gott sey gelobet, Oder: Sey lob und ehr mit hohem preiß von der gantzen Kirchen beschlossen werden.

During the communion, while the sacrament is dispensed and distributed, the church shall sing one or more of the songs hereafter set, according as the communicants are many or few, as: "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; on the high feast days, the Agnus Dei, "O Lamb of God, innocent," "O Christ, we thank thee for thy goodness." After the communion the collect shall be sung by the preacher, thereupon the accustomed blessing or benediction (Numbers 6) spoken toward the people, and at the last it shall be concluded by the whole church with a song of thanks, as "God be praised," or "Praise and honour with high price."

Regensburg first sang the Latin Agnus Dei three times, slowly. If that was not long enough, a Latin thanksgiving from the gradual followed. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, p. 393):

> Unter diser des volks speisung singet der schulmaister das Agnus Dei dreimal langsam. Wo aber der communicanten so vil sind, das die drei Agnus Dei nit gelangen mögen, bis man si alle verrichtet, so wirdet ein lateinische danksagung darzu gesungen, wie man die im gradual am bequemsten finden kan.

During this feeding of the people the schoolmaster singeth the Agnus Dei three times slowly. But where the communicants are so many that the three Agnus Deis will not reach until all have been served, then a Latin thanksgiving is sung thereto, as the most fitting can be found in the gradual.

Hof lists what was to be added "for the multitude of communicants". Hof's sequences in Latin and German come first, then *Discubuit*, then four German hymns, and then, if still needed, the short hymns otherwise sung after the sermon. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

> His propter communicantium multitudinem non sufficientibus, addantur eodem modo, quo ad organa et choros, germanicae cantilenae NB. Item sequentiae notae, in lingua latina et germanica compositae ad festa praecipua. Praeterea responso[…]rium Discubuit Jesus, in secunda parte missalis latini. 1. Jesus Christus unser Heiland, Johann Hussens. 2. Ich dank dem Herrn von ganzem herzen. 3. Erbarm dich mein, o Herr Gott. 4. Es wolt uns Gott genedig sein. Alles nach zal und meng der communicanten, also das auch folgende gesanglein (welche sonsten am sontag, desgleichen mittwoch und freitag nach vollendter predigt gesungen werden) zu end der communion mit hinangehenk[et werden können].

These not sufficing because of the multitude of communicants, let German songs be added in the same manner as regards organ and choirs. Note: item the known sequences, composed in the Latin and German tongues, for the chief feasts. Moreover the responsory *Discubuit Jesus*, in the second part of the Latin missal. 1. "Jesus Christ our Saviour," John Hus's. 2. "I thank the Lord with all my heart." 3. "Have mercy on me, O Lord God." 4. "May God be gracious unto us." All according to the number and multitude of the communicants, so that the following little songs also (which are otherwise sung on Sunday, and likewise Wednesday and Friday, after the sermon is ended) [may be] hung on at the end of the communion.

Wittenberg lists hymns "until the communion is over", including festal hymns. **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 705):

> Weil das volk communicirt, singt man sanctus; agnus dei; Jesus Christus unser heiland; got sei gelobt; das deutsch confitebor tibi; pange lingua lateinisch und dergleichen, auch deutsche gesenge vom feste etc. bis die communion aus ist.

While the people communicate, one singeth the Sanctus; the Agnus Dei; "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; "God be praised"; the German *Confitebor tibi*; *Pange lingua* in Latin, and the like; also German songs of the feast, etc., until the communion is over.

#### 8.14.3 The song stops when the communion ends

Bugenhagen's orders stop the hymn at the end of the distribution, even in mid-hymn, and go straight to the German Agnus Dei. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

> De wile de communicatio waret, schal de kerke singen ein agnus dei latinisch eder düdesch: O lam gades etc., Jesus Christus etc., Godt si gelavet etc., den psalm confitebor; overst nicht lenger den de communicatio waret, wenn de lüde sind tom sacrament gangen, so singet me ein ander düdesch agnus dei: Christe, du lam gades etc.

While the communion lasteth, the church shall sing an Agnus Dei in Latin or German, "O Lamb of God," etc., "Jesus Christ," etc., "God be praised," etc., the psalm *Confitebor*; but no longer than the communion lasteth. When the people have gone to the sacrament, another German Agnus Dei is sung, "Christ, thou Lamb of God," etc.

The appendix of the same order is sharper still: "all other singing shall then straightway cease, notwithstanding that a song begun be not sung out with all its verses" (Sehling 4, p. 344):

> Dat dudesche agnus dei; so balde de lüde communiceret hebben, alle andere sank sal denne flux uphören, unangesehn ein angehaven leed mit allen verschen nicht utgesungen si: Christe, du lam gades, de du drechst de sund der werld, vorbarm di unser.

The German Agnus Dei: as soon as the people have communicated, all other singing shall then straightway cease, notwithstanding that a song begun be not sung out with all its verses: "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us."

**Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 155):

> Me schal ock nicht lenger singen, alse de berichtinge waret, wen de uthe is, schal ock de sank uphören. Unde denne also vort in den steden und dörperen schal me anfangen: O lam gades unschüldig dre mal, edder Christe, du lam gades.

One shall also not sing longer than the communion lasteth; when that is out, the singing also shall cease. And then forthwith in the towns and villages one shall begin "O Lamb of God, innocent," three times, or "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

**Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 91):

> So hevet de Scholemeister vort an: Jhesus Christus, unser Heiland etc., Edder wat anders, dat dem gelick ys. Wen de berichtinge uthe ys, so höret ock up de Sanck.

Then the schoolmaster beginneth forthwith "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or something else that is like it. When the communion is out, the singing also ceaseth.

**Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 553):

> Wenn nu de communicanten gan tom altare schollen de gesänge vam sacramente gesungen werden: Jesus Christus etc., Godt sie gelavet etc. effte na gelegenheit der feste süss ein gude gesang, doch also, dat de organiste stedes mank her spele, und dat de chore gelickwoll alle verse singe. Up den festen, wen dar veele communicanten sin, unde ock sünst up den sondagen, schall men mehr singen dat agnus dei latine, underwilen ock düdesch, Christe du lamme gades etc. Wenn nu de communion geschehen, schall dat chor uphören to singen.

When now the communicants go to the altar, the songs of the sacrament shall be sung, "Jesus Christ," etc., "God be praised," etc., or, according to the occasion of the feasts, else a good song; yet so that the organist play always in between, and that the choir nevertheless sing all the verses. On the feasts, when there are many communicants, and also otherwise on the Sundays, one shall sing more: the Agnus Dei in Latin, at times also in German, "Christ, thou Lamb of God," etc. When now the communion hath taken place, the choir shall cease singing.

In the Kurpfalz order the minister could stop the singing if the service ran too long. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 165):

> Es were dann, das von wegen der communicanten anzahl oder anderer dergleichen zufälligen ursachen der actus etwas zu lang sein wolte, so mag der minister mit dem gesang abzubrechen bevehlen.

Unless it were that, by reason of the number of communicants or other such chance causes, the action would grow somewhat too long; then the minister may command the singing to be broken off.

#### 8.14.4 Stanzas between the actions

In the earliest Low German Mass from Schleswig-Holstein the choir sang one stanza of "Jesus Christus unser Heiland" after the consecration of the bread, the next during the distribution of the bread, and then fell silent until the cup. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526]** (Sehling 23, pp. 56–57):

> Nu hevet dat cor an to syngende: Jhesus Christus, unse hylant. Eyn versch dar van. Dar na kert sick de prester myt dem licham Cristi thom volchke.

Now the choir beginneth to sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," one verse thereof. Thereafter the priest turneth himself with the body of Christ to the people.

> Unde singet ßo lange, dat de licham Christi vordelet is. Dar na swicht dat chor stille. Unde de prester hevet vordan an, dat bloth Christi tho consecrerende.

And [the choir] singeth so long until the body of Christ is distributed. Thereafter the choir keepeth still, and the priest beginneth further to consecrate the blood of Christ.

Bugenhagen's Hamburg order has the same pattern for bread and cup: the song stops when the communicants have received the bread, and after the cup the rest of the hymn is sung, or more is begun. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 529):

> De wile singet dat volk: Jesus Christus etc., edder: God si gelavet und gebenediet etc. Wen averst de communicanten sin togegaen, so schall de sank uphoren und de prester neme den kelk und drege den bevel Christi vordtan.

Meanwhile the people sing "Jesus Christ," etc., or "God be praised and blessed," etc. But when the communicants have come forward, the singing shall cease, and the priest shall take the cup and set forth the command of Christ further.

#### 8.14.5 The Latin pieces and the German hymns beside them

Brandenburg began with the Latin *Discubuit Jesus* and added German hymns if there were many communicants. One German hymn was to be sung after the communion in any case. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 70):

> Darauf sol angefangen werden das responsorium discubuit Jesus latinisch und ob der communicanten viel weren, das man damit nicht zureichen mocht, sol man dem volk deudsch anfahen zu singen, gott sei gelobet, oder Jesus Christus, unser heiland, welcher gesenge einer, ob auch gleich das discubuit zureichet, dennoch gleichwol nach der communion sol gesungen werden.

Thereupon the responsory *Discubuit Jesus* shall be begun in Latin; and if the communicants were many, so that it would not reach, one shall begin to sing German to the people, "God be praised," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; one of which songs, even though the *Discubuit* should suffice, shall nevertheless be sung after the communion.

**Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 97):

> Under der communion singt das volck den gesang Jhesus Cristus, unser heilandt, oder Gott sei gelobet oder sonst ein cristlichen teutschen psalmen oder auch der chor das responsorium: Discubuit Jesus cum discipulis suis oder das teutsche pange lingua. Nach der communion singt der chor die agnus Dei.

During the communion the people sing the song "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "God be praised," or else a Christian German psalm; or the choir also the responsory *Discubuit Jesus cum discipulis suis*, or the German *Pange lingua*. After the communion the choir singeth the Agnus Dei.

**Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 460):

> Darna treden de Communicanten tho, Am ersten de menne, darna de frowen. Under middeler tidt singet de Scholemester: O sacrum convivium Unde Jhesus Christus unse Heilandt edder Sanctus unde Agnus Dei.

Thereafter the communicants come forward, first the men, thereafter the women. In the meantime the schoolmaster singeth *O sacrum convivium* and "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or the Sanctus and Agnus Dei.

At Heilbronn the Latin and German *Pange lingua* were sung in alternation with "Gott sei gelobet". **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 17/1, pp. 285–286):

> Darumb singt man den Himnum Pange lingua, latin und deutsch, mitt dem […] lobgesanng: Gott sey gelobett unnd gebenedeiet etc.

Therefore one singeth the hymn *Pange lingua*, Latin and German, with the song of praise "God be praised and blessed," etc.

The Heilbronn song order of 1543 turns to the German and Latin Te Deum at great communions. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 323):

> Unter dem Nachtmahl Sanctus oder Agnus dei (lat.) oder Pange lingua (lat./deutsch) mit Orgel. An hohen Festen oder bei viel Communicanten Te deum laudamus deutsch und latein und Orgel (1 Vers um den andern). Beschluß: Grates nunc omnes auf der Orgel.

During the Supper, the Sanctus or Agnus Dei (Latin), or *Pange lingua* (Latin and German), with the organ. On high feasts, or with many communicants, the *Te Deum laudamus* in German and Latin with the organ (one verse after the other). Conclusion: *Grates nunc omnes* on the organ.

### 8.14.6 Other hymns in the slot

Bugenhagen allowed "often" other hymns: "Nun freut euch", the baptism hymn, and German hymns of the feasts. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 57):

> Dewyle singet dat volk: Jhesus Christus, unse heiland etc. Edder: Got sy gelavet und gebenediet etc. Edder den psalm: Confitebor düdesch etc. Men mach tho tyden und wol vaken ock andere ledere under der communio singen, also: Nu frouet ju etc. Item van der döpe etc. und gude ledere, psalme und hymnos düdesch van den festen.

Meanwhile the people sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "God be praised and blessed," etc., or the psalm *Confitebor* in German, etc. One may at times, and well often, sing also other songs under the communion, as "Now rejoice," etc., item the one of baptism, etc., and good songs, psalms and hymns in German of the feasts.

**Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

> drauf sol der organist schlahen und die kirche singen Jesus Christus unser heiland, und dazu, wen der communicanten viel ist, gott sei gelobet und helf gott, das mirs gelinge.

thereupon the organist shall play and the church sing "Jesus Christ our Saviour," and thereto, when the communicants are many, "God be praised" and "Help, God, that I may succeed."

**Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583** (Sehling 7/1, p. 681):

> Sub communione vero sive canatur: Was kan unß kommen an für not, od. O Christ, wir danken deiner güt, od. Jesus Christus, unser heyland, od. Nun freuet euch, lieben christengemein, et id genus alia cantica, sive ludatur organis.

But during the communion let there be sung either "What need can come upon us," or "O Christ, we thank thee for thy goodness," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," and other songs of that kind; or let the organ be played.

At Ortenburg "at times also the Passion" was sung, according as the communicants were many or few. **Ortenburg, 1563** (Sehling 13, p. 532):

> Unter solcher austailung aber hat der chor gesungen Jesus Christus, unser Herr, oder Jesus Christus unser Hailand, zu zeiten auch den passion, nachdem der communicanten vil oder wenig gewesen sind.

But during such distribution the choir hath sung "Jesus Christ our Lord," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour," at times also the Passion, according as the communicants have been many or few.

Limpurg changed the communion hymn by season: the Passion in Lent and "Christ lag in Todesbanden" on Easter Day. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 620):

> Under dern Communion singe der Schuelmeister eintweder des Hussen gesang: Jesus Christus, unser haillandt etc. Oder: Nun frewet Euch, Lieben Christen gemain. Item: Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeyet. In der Fasten den Passion, am Ostertag: Christ lag inn todtes banden.

During the communion let the schoolmaster sing either Hus's song, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "Now rejoice, dear Christians all"; item "God be praised and blessed." In Lent the Passion; on Easter Day, "Christ lay in the bands of death."

At Strasbourg Psalm 51 was sung at "great communions". **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577** (Sehling 20/1, p. 516):

> Under der communion singt man entweder: Jesus Christus, unser heyland, Johan Hussen lied, oder: Gott sey gelobet und gebenedeyet, oder wens grosse communion sind: O herre Gott, begnade mich, oder sonst ein gesang de tempore.

During the communion one singeth either "Jesus Christ our Saviour," John Hus's song, or "God be praised and blessed," or, when there are great communions, "O Lord God, be gracious unto me," or else a song of the season.

In the village order of Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein*, Sebald Heyden's "Als Jesus Christus unser Herr" was the first choice, with the shorter hymns "if that be too long". **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 502):

> Inmittels sol die kirch singen den gesang Als Jesus Christus, unser Herr, oder, wo solches zu lang - Gott sei gelobet oder Jesus Christus unser Heiland.

Meanwhile the church shall sing the song "When Jesus Christ our Lord," or, where that is too long, "God be praised," or "Jesus Christ our Saviour."

The Kassel general synod of 1607, as Hesse turned Reformed, kept "Gott sei gelobet". Beside it stood Lobwasser's Psalms 23, 103 and 111, "according to the occasion and number of the communicants". **Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 75):

> und, da coena Domini, under wehrender communion der gesang: Gott sey gelobt undt gebenedeiet etc. oder sonstenn als den Lobwasser der 23., 103., 111. psalm nach gelegenheitt undt anzall der communicanten.

and when the Lord's Supper is held, during the communion the song "God be praised and blessed," etc., or else, as out of Lobwasser, the twenty-third, hundred and third, hundred and eleventh psalm, according to the occasion and number of the communicants.

### 8.14.7 Choir, people and organ

Brenz wanted the choir in Latin and the church in German by turns, so that the communicants were admonished "not only inwardly but outwardly by the understandable song". **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 51):

> Hie zwuschen sol der Cor latheinisch und die kirch teutsch umbeinander singen, auff das die entpfaher des Sacraments und andere umbstender nit allein inwendig, sonder außwendig durch das verstendtlich gesang irs thuns ermant werden.

Herebetween the choir shall sing in Latin and the church in German by turns, that the receivers of the sacrament and others standing about may be admonished of their doing, not only inwardly, but outwardly through the understandable song.

Pomerania limited the organ during the communion, forbade worldly tunes on it, and had choir and people sing alternate verses so that the hymns would be learned by all. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 439):

> Under der communion singet men: Jesus Christus unser heiland etc., edder: Godt si gelavet etc., edder: O lam gades unschüldich etc., Christe du lam gades, item: Ick danke dem herren van ganzem herten etc. mit der note, de im düdischen sankboke steit, unde der geliken düdische senge, de sick up de communion rimen. Item, discubuit Iesus, item de latinischen agnus dei, choral, item o sacrum convivium etc. Wenn dise gesenge under der communion gesungen werden, schölen de organisten eren gesank mit der orgel deste körter maken, unde nene weltlike, lichtverdige gesenge slan. De pastor schal vorschaffen, dat de orgeln der maten modereret werden, dat men de düdischen psalme under der communion mit der gemeine ganz tom ende singe, unde dat de vörgesetteden gesenge ummeschichtich gesungen werden, dat dat chor unde dat volk einen vers umme den andern singe, up dat se alle to gelick den schölern unde der gemeine gebrücklick werden.

During the communion one singeth "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., or "God be praised," etc., or "O Lamb of God, innocent," etc., "Christ, thou Lamb of God," item "I thank the Lord with all my heart," etc., with the note that standeth in the German songbook, and the like German songs that rhyme with the communion. Item *Discubuit Jesus*, item the Latin Agnus Dei, in plainsong, item *O sacrum convivium*, etc. When these songs are sung during the communion, the organists shall make their song with the organ the shorter, and play no worldly, light songs. The pastor shall see to it that the organs be so moderated that the German psalms during the communion be sung wholly to the end with the congregation, and that the aforesaid songs be sung by turns, the choir and the people one verse after another, that they may all alike become familiar to the scholars and the congregation.

Schönburg let the organ play during the communion only on high feasts. **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

> Sub communione mag man abwechselsweise singen das teutsche santus etc., als Jesus Christus, zuweilen das lateinische sanctus oder agnus dei novi testamenti. Der organista soll sub communione nicht schlagen, es sei denn an hohen festen.

During the communion one may sing by turns the German Sanctus, etc., as "Jesus Christ," at times the Latin Sanctus or Agnus Dei of the New Testament. The organist shall not play during the communion, unless on high feasts.

The organ's alternation with choir and people is treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.3.

#### 8.14.8 How fixed the slot was

**Fixed core, open margin.** Every order opens the slot with Hus's hymn, "Gott sei gelobet", the German Sanctus or Psalm 111. What changed from service to service was not the choice but the quantity, measured by the number of communicants. The hymns added at the margin were festal hymns on feasts, the Passion in Lent, Latin chants where there was a school, and psalms of penitence or thanks.

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## 8.15 The Agnus Dei, the thanksgiving, and the close

#### 8.15.1 "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" after the communion

In Bugenhagen's orders, and in those that followed them, the German Agnus Dei "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" was sung after all had communicated. It was sung three times, the third time ending "gib uns deinen Frieden". It served as the people's thanksgiving, addressed to Christ in heaven. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 529):

> Wen se averst alle communiceret hebben und sint up eren steden, so singen se und alle volk to Christo im hemele dat dudesche agnus dei dremal also: Christe, du lam gades, de du drechst de sunde der werldt, erbarm di unser; tom drudden: giff uns dinen frede. Amen.

But when they have all communicated and are in their places, they and all the people sing to Christ in heaven the German Agnus Dei three times, thus: "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us"; the third time, "give us thy peace. Amen."

The Braunschweig order of 1528 has the same rubric (Sehling 6/1, p. 442). The Albertine order lets any of the German communion hymns be closed with "Christe, du Lamm Gottes". **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539**, variants A and B (Sehling 1, p. 275):

> so man der deutschen gesenge (als Jesus Christus unser heiland u. s. w., item, das deudsche sanctus, Esaia dem propheten das geschah, item den psalm ich danke dem herrn von ganzem herzen u. s. w.) eines oder mehr gesungen hat, mag man mit dem folgenden deutschen agnus dei beschliessen: [folgen die Noten zu Christe du lamb gottes, der du tregst die sünd der welt, erbarm dich unser. Verleih uns dein [fried].

when one or more of the German songs have been sung (as "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., item the German Sanctus, "Isaiah the prophet, it befell," item the psalm "I thank the Lord with all my heart," etc.), one may conclude with the German Agnus Dei following: [the notes follow to "Christ, thou Lamb of God, that bearest the sin of the world, have mercy upon us. Grant us thy peace."]

**Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 199):

> Unter der communion singe man Jesus Christus, unser heiland. Item, Gott sei gelobet, Agnus dei, Esaia, dem propheten. Und so der communicanten viel sind, singe man den CXI. psalm: Ich danke dem herrn von ganzem herzen. Wie er im deudschen gesang buch stehet. Desgleichen andere deudsche geistliche lieder. Und zum beschlus: Christe, du lam gottes.

During the communion let "Jesus Christ our Saviour" be sung; item "God be praised," the Agnus Dei, "Isaiah the prophet." And when the communicants are many, let the hundred and eleventh psalm be sung, "I thank the Lord with all my heart," as it standeth in the German songbook; likewise other German spiritual songs. And at the close, "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

At Suhl the boys sang songs of the season or of the sacrament during the communion, "and it is commonly concluded with the song *Christe du Lamm Gottes*". **Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 351):

> Communio sub quam canunt pueri de tempore aut sacramento, und wird gemeiniglich mit dem gesang: Christe du lamb gottes beschlossen.

The communion, during which the boys sing [songs] of the season or of the sacrament; and it is commonly concluded with the song "Christ, thou Lamb of God."

Neuenrade has "Agnus Dei Düdsch" as the communicants go to the altar and "Gott sei gelobet" after. **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 519):

> Als dan singet man Agnus Dei Düdsch, und gan de Communicanten thom Altar. Na dem Agnus Dei singet man: God sy gelovet, etc.

Then one singeth the Agnus Dei in German, and the communicants go to the altar. After the Agnus Dei one singeth "God be praised," etc.

### 8.15.2 "Gott sei gelobet" as the thanksgiving

Luther's *Formula missae* already wanted "Gott sei gelobet" sung after the communion. He dropped the stanza about receiving the sacrament at the hour of death "from the hands of the consecrated priest". **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 9):

> Interim placet illam cantari post communionem: ‘Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet, der uns selber hat gespeiset etct.’ Omissa ista particula: ‘Und das heilige sacramente, an unserm letzten ende, aus des geweieten priesters hende’.

Meanwhile it pleaseth [me] that this be sung after the communion: "God be praised and blessed, who himself hath fed us," etc.; that little part being left out, "And the holy sacrament at our last end, out of the consecrated priest's hands."

The Albertine order ends the service with it: "and therewith go home" (Sehling 1, p. 275):

> So mag man das volk singen lassen den gesang: gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet und damit heim gehen.

Then the people may be let sing the song "God be praised and blessed," and therewith go home.

**Rothenberg, *Vereinigung*, 1618** (Sehling 13, p. 550):

> Unter derselben sing man psalm und gesäng, so darzu gehören. Nach vollendter communion sing man zur danksagung für dieselbe: Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet etc.

During the same let psalms and songs be sung that belong thereto. After the communion is ended let "God be praised and blessed," etc. be sung for thanksgiving for the same.

### 8.15.3 The closing hymn

The last hymn of the service was one of a small group: "Gott sei gelobet", "Dank sagen wir alle", "Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis" (the last stanza of "Es ist das Heil"), "Erhalt uns" with "Verleih uns Frieden", *Da pacem*, "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein", or a festal hymn. Where the Mass ended with the *Benedicamus*, in Latin or German, these hymns followed it or, in some orders, stood in its place (§§8.16.8–8.16.9). Tecklenburg closes with thanksgiving. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 244):

> Endtlich sal dat volck den heren loven und dancken em van ganßen herten mit dem gesange: Danck seggen wy alle etc., Mit fride und [frouwden of dergelichen duischer danckseggingе].

At the last the people shall praise the Lord and thank him with all their heart with the song "Thanks say we all," etc., "In peace and [joy," or the like German thanksgiving].

Northeim closes with the prayer for peace, because "for temporal peace we are bound to pray at all times". **Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 926):

> Wir sehen auch fur gut an, das zu endlichem beschlus der gesang Da pacem, Domine in lateinischer oder deudscher sprache gesungen werde durch die knaben und schulmeister. Denn umb zeitlichen frid sind wir zu bitten allezeit schüldig.

We also think good that for the final close the song *Da pacem, Domine* be sung in the Latin or German tongue by the boys and schoolmaster. For we are bound at all times to pray for temporal peace.

In Mecklenburg priest, communicants and congregation knelt for "Erhalt uns" and "Verleih uns Frieden". **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 155):

> Unde denne schal sick de prester vor dat altar up de knee setten. De ganze gemene schal ock so don, unde heven an: Erholt uns here bi dinem worde, de dre versche, unde denn: Vorlene uns frede gnedichlick, here godt etc.

And then the priest shall set himself upon his knees before the altar. The whole congregation shall also do so, and begin "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," the three verses, and then "Grant us peace graciously, Lord God," etc.

Buxtehude closed with *Da pacem* or "Verleih uns Frieden", sung without the organ, or "a psalm fitting the present need", such as "Mitten wir im Leben sind". **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 76):

> To beschlute schall dat de chorr allene ahne de orgel singen: Da pacem, edder dudesch Vorlene uns frede, edder sunst einen psalm, de na ahnliggende nodt darto bequeme, alse Midden wy im levent sint, edder andere dem gelick.

At the close the choir alone, without the organ, shall sing *Da pacem*, or in German "Grant us peace," or else a psalm fitting thereto according to the present need, as "In the midst of life we are," or others like it.

**Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 553):

> Tom lesten schall dat chor Da pacem etc. singen effte düdesch vorlene uns frede etc. up sünderlicke feste averst einen andern gesank, de sick darbi wil schicken.

At the last the choir shall sing *Da pacem*, etc., or in German "Grant us peace," etc.; but on special feasts another song that will fit thereto.

Hoya gives the festal closing hymns. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

> Darnach singet man Es wol uns Gott genedig sein etc. An den festen aber singet man, was die fest mit sich bringen, als auf Weynachten Gelobet seystu, Jhesu Christ, sampt den folgenden versen, auf Ostern das kurze Jhesus Christus, unser heyland, der den tod uberwand, auf Pfingsten Kom, heiliger Geist, Herre Gott etc.

Thereafter one singeth "May God be gracious unto us," etc. But on the feasts one singeth what the feasts bring with them, as at Christmas "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," with the verses following; at Easter the short "Jesus Christ our Saviour, who overcame death"; at Pentecost "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God," etc.

**Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 439):

> Tom beslute wert gesungen: Si loff unde ehre etc., edder: Erholt uns herre etc., Vorlene uns frede etc., O godt wi danken diner güde etc. unde der geliken.

At the close is sung "Praise and honour," etc., or "Keep us, Lord," etc., "Grant us peace," etc., "O God, we thank thee for thy goodness," etc., and the like.

**Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 783):

> wan das gescheen, singet der opferman mit dem volke zum lesten aus: Sei lob und ehr mit hohem preis.

when that is done, the sexton with the people singeth at the last, to the end: "Praise and honour with high price."

In the Braunschweig villages two closing hymns alternated, one holy day after the other (Sehling 6/1, p. 473):

> Und zum besluß schal dan der opferman mit dem volk singen ein fiertag umb den andern: Es wolt unß Godt genedig sein und: Erhalt uns, Her, bei deinem wort.

And at the close the sexton shall sing with the people, one holy day after the other, "May God be gracious unto us" and "Keep us, Lord, by thy word."

#### 8.15.4 The closing hymn covers the priest's devesting

In the Hildesheim city order the closing hymn was sung while the celebrant took off his vestment and knelt again at the altar to give thanks privately. **Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 855):

> So hevet de scholmester an einen düdeschen, korten psalm, edder wat öhme gefellich unde darmede ein ende etc. Dewile överst de sank waret, tüt sick de prediger ut unde lecht dat missgewand tohope, kneet wedder nedder vor dem altare unde danket Godde hemehck vor sick sülvest.

Then the schoolmaster beginneth a German short psalm, or what pleaseth him, and therewith an end, etc. But while the song lasteth, the preacher undresseth himself and layeth the Mass vestment together, kneeleth down again before the altar, and thanketh God secretly for himself.

#### 8.15.5 A custom found and left alone

A Henneberg pastor found "Verleih uns Frieden" sung at the very end in his parish. He left it, since it could not be faulted. **Wasungen (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 356):

> So nu die communion geschehen, beschleust man mit der collecta und dem segen. Verleihe uns friden mit der anhengten collecta hab ich hie also gefunden, das mans gar am ent gesungen und damit beschlossen, welches weil es nit zu strafen, hab ichs auch nit endern wollen.

When now the communion is done, one concludeth with the collect and the blessing. "Grant us peace," with the collect appended, I have found here thus: that it was sung at the very end and therewith concluded; which, since it is not to be blamed, I also would not change.

#### 8.15.6 How fixed the slots were

**Fixed, with a handful of choices and festal exchange.** The post-communion Agnus was "Christe, du Lamm Gottes" or "O Lamm Gottes". The thanksgiving was "Gott sei gelobet", "Dank sagen wir alle" or "Sei Lob und Ehr". The close was the prayer for peace and the word ("Verleih uns Frieden", *Da pacem*, "Erhalt uns"), or Psalm 67. At the high feasts the festal hymn of the day took the closing slot.

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## 8.16 Vespers, matins, the catechism and the weekday services

#### 8.16.1 Office hymns: only of the season, and only if pure

The Latin office hymn (*hymnus*) of matins and vespers stayed where there was a school. The rule was that it be "of the season" and "pure". Hymns to the saints were dropped, and single stanzas that invoked the saints or the cross were cut. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 224, Latin; p. 245, German):

> Hymnos praeterquam de tempore nullos admittimus.

We admit no hymns save those of the season.

> Die hymnos helt man auch nach der zeit und keine andern.

The hymns also are kept according to the season, and no others.

Schleswig-Holstein warns against hymns that speak of the merit and invocation of the saints. It names the *O crux ave* stanza of *Vexilla regis*. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 143):

> So erfordert ock de Godtsalicheit unde Christlike Gelove, Dat wy uns vor de Hymnos waren scholen, Darynne van vordenst unde Anropinge der Hilligen geschreven steit, den wol wolde hernamals ein Hölten Crütze upheven unde den godtlosen sang singen: O Crux, Ave spes unica etc.?

So also godliness and the Christian faith require that we beware of the hymns wherein is written of the merit and invocation of the saints. For who would hereafter lift up a wooden cross and sing the godless song, *O Crux, ave spes unica*, etc.?

The Ansbach chapter order of 1533 made the same cut. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 316):

> dominica in passione Domini: In hymno Vexilla Regis soll der vers O crux, ave spes ausgelassen werden.

On Passion Sunday: in the hymn *Vexilla Regis* the verse *O crux, ave spes* shall be left out.

The Heilbronn song order of 1543 cuts the Marian stanza of the Candlemas hymn. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 322):

> Lichtmeß: Hymnus: Quod chorus vatum (vor Tu libens votis, ist auszulassen).

Candlemas: hymn *Quod chorus vatum* (before *Tu libens votis*, which is to be left out).

At Hof the hymns of John the Baptist and the apostles were sung in the text "corrected in Lossius". **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 423):

> H: Ut queant laxis (correctus in Lossio].

Hymn: *Ut queant laxis* (corrected in Lossius).

At Regensburg the vesper hymn of the season was sung "if it be not godless". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 419):

> und alspald darauf bede chör den hymnum de tempore, so er nit gotlos ist.

and straightway thereupon both choirs [sing] the hymn of the season, if it be not godless.

#### 8.16.2 One hymn for a whole season

The office hymn changed by season, not by day. Hof kept the German Te Deum at vespers from Michaelmas to Advent. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 447):

> Vesperi. Hymnus: Herr Gott, dich loben wir. NB. Hymnus iste retinetur usque ad Adventum Christi.

At vespers. Hymn: "Lord God, we praise thee." N.B.: This hymn is kept until the Advent of Christ.

Heilbronn kept *O lux beata Trinitas* from Trinity to Advent. **Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 321):

> Trinitatis bis Advent: Zu gewöhnlichen christlichen Antiphonen Hymnus: O lux beata Trinitas zu singen.

Trinity until Advent: with the customary Christian antiphons the hymn *O lux beata Trinitas* is to be sung.

The Henneberg afternoon service opened with a seasonal hymn, played on the organ, then sung in figured music, and then followed by the German Magnificat of the whole congregation. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 310):

> und dann auf die hohe fest, als weinachten, das deutsche grates nunc omnes, und, Gelobet seistu Jesu Christ, bis ohngefehrlich umb purificationis, von dem sontage nach purificationis an, das deutsche Nunc dimittis, bis auf die fasten; durch die fasten bis auf ostern Christe der du bist tag und licht; von ostern bis zum auffarts tage Also heilig ist der tag, oder Christ ist erstanden, oder Christ lag in todes banden; vom auffarts tage an bis uf pfingsten, Christ fuhr gen himel; von pfingsten an, vom heiligen geist, bis aufs advent; im advent bis auf weinachten, Nu kom der heiden heiland, alle sontage nach mittage auf der orgel, wo die verhanden, geschlagen und darauf eben dasselbe als balden figuriret, als dann das magnificat durch den cantor und chor mit der ganzen gemeine gesungen werden.

and then on the high feasts, as Christmas, the German *Grates nunc omnes* and "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," until about the Purification; from the Sunday after the Purification, the German *Nunc dimittis*, until Lent; through Lent until Easter, "Christ, who art the day and light"; from Easter until Ascension Day, "So holy is the day," or "Christ is arisen," or "Christ lay in the bands of death"; from Ascension Day until Pentecost, "Christ went up to heaven"; from Pentecost, [a song] of the Holy Ghost until Advent; in Advent until Christmas, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen": all Sundays in the afternoon played upon the organ, where there is one, and thereupon the same straightway sung in figured music; then the Magnificat [shall be] sung by the cantor and choir with the whole congregation.

In the Pomeranian *Agenda* vespers opened, kneeling, with *Veni sancte Spiritus* or a Latin song of the season "pro ingressu vel egressu". The schoolmaster chose it with the pastor. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

> Erstlick singet men flexis genibus: Veni sancte spiritus; edder den ersten vers: Veni creator spiritus; edder Adesto deus unus etc., edder wat süs pro tempore evenkömlick is: Alse im advent: Veni domine visitare nos in pace etc.; umme winachten: Puer natus in Bethlehem, In dulci iubilo, Resonet in laudibus, Nunc angelorum gloria; umme paschen: Surrexit Christus hodie; umme pingsten: Spiritus sancti gratia, Veni maxime spiritus etc. Alse sölckes de scholmeister edder cantor, mit rat des pastorn, wert vor gut anseen, wat pro ingressu vel egressu deenstlick is.

First one singeth on bended knees *Veni sancte Spiritus*, or the first verse *Veni creator Spiritus*, or *Adesto Deus unus*, etc., or what else is fitting for the season: as in Advent, *Veni Domine visitare nos in pace*, etc.; about Christmas, *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus*, *Nunc angelorum gloria*; about Easter, *Surrexit Christus hodie*; about Pentecost, *Spiritus sancti gratia*, *Veni maxime Spiritus*, etc.: as the schoolmaster or cantor, with the counsel of the pastor, shall think good what is serviceable for the entrance or the going out.

#### 8.16.3 Latin for the school, German for the people

Bugenhagen kept the Latin office for the school, and moved the German hymns to the times when the laity were present. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 524):

> Sulcke latinsche senge werden den leien ohre dudesche senge nicht vorhinderen, wente se werden gesungen werden, wen de leien in der karcken mit prediken tohorende nicht to schaffende hebben. Se werden doch sus genoch dudesch to singende krigen. Wente vor allen sermonen und na allen sermonen scollen [se dudesch singen].

Such Latin songs will not hinder the laity in their German songs, for they will be sung when the laity have nothing to do in the church with hearing preaching. They will get enough to sing in German otherwise. For before all sermons and after all sermons they shall [sing in German].

**Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 442):

> Düdesche hymnos in der Advente, imme Wynachten bet up purificationis, up Paschen bet up Pynxten, imme Pynxten, van den festen edder sus andere hymnos mach me wol singen des hilgendages in der vesper, wen de leyen dar [synt].

German hymns in Advent, at Christmas until the Purification, at Easter until Pentecost, at Pentecost, of the feasts, or else other hymns, may well be sung on the holy day at vespers, when the laity are there.

**Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 856):

> To den andern predigen ys ydt genoch, dat wy einen psalm vor unde einen psalm edder ledt na düdesch singen. Wenn överst unse scholkinder allene to der kercken komen, to singen unde to lesen, wat vorordent ys, so schal se nemandes vorhindern, latinisch to lesen unde to singen.

At the other sermons it is enough that we sing a psalm before and a psalm or song after in German. But when our school children come alone to the church, to sing and to read what is ordained, no one shall hinder them from reading and singing in Latin.

#### 8.16.4 The German Te Deum sung verse by verse

The German canticles — the Te Deum, Magnificat, Benedictus and Nunc dimittis — were the congregational pieces of the offices. The Te Deum was sung by alternating halves, the choir one verse and the people the next. At Wittenberg a school usher stood in a stall in the middle of the church to lead the people "until the people grow used to it". **Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 705):

> und ein schulgesell soll in dem schulerstul mitten in der kirchen mit dem volk auf alle halbe vers, wie es gemacht ist, antworten. Er mag auch zum ersten etliche knaben in den stul zu hulf nehmen, bis das volk sich gewent, solch te deum mitzusingen.

and a school usher shall, in the scholars' stall in the midst of the church, answer every half verse with the people, as it is made. He may also at first take some boys into the stall to help, until the people grow used to singing along such Te Deum.

**Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 924):

> Und wiewol man die latinische sprache aus der kirchen gar nicht komen lassen sol, so ist aber doch fur gut angesehen, das das Te Deum, damit auch in der kirchen die gemeine nicht vergeblich sey, auf die Sontage und hei[...]ligen tage deudsch gesungen werde, doch also, das der chor einen vers, die ganze kirche den andern singe.

And although the Latin tongue shall by no means be let go out of the church, yet it is thought good that the Te Deum be sung in German on the Sundays and holy days, that the congregation too be not in the church in vain; yet so that the choir sing one verse, the whole church the other.

At Calenberg the sexton came out of the choir to lead the congregation's half. **Calenberg- Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 792):

> Nach dem responsorio das Te Deum laudamus deutsch, also das der chor einen vers, die gemein haussen den anderen singe. Sonderlich aber mus der opferman aus dem chor hie tretten und die gemein, das sie fein ordentlich singe, regiren.

After the responsory the *Te Deum laudamus* in German, so that the choir sing one verse, the congregation outside the other. But especially here the sexton must step out of the choir and govern the congregation, that it sing finely in order.

### 8.16.5 The evening *Salve* replaced

The late-medieval evening devotion of the *Salve Regina* was abolished, or turned to Christ. **Plauen, *Ordnung der Ceremonien*, 1529** (Sehling 2, p. 111):

> Ufn abend umb 5 ader 6 hor singen die knaben alle tage das „Salve Jesu Christe“ mit dem „Da pacem“ latinisch und einer deutschen collecta.

In the evening at five or six o'clock the boys sing every day the *Salve Jesu Christe* with the *Da pacem* in Latin and a German collect.

At Heilbronn a German hymn took the place of the *Salve* as an evening blessing. **Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 302):

> Zu nacht umb salve zeytt: Das an statt des vorigen salve zu einem schlaff segen der schulmaister mit seinen knaben ain theutsch loblich gsang als die letany oder das Mitten wir im leben seind oder Da pacem domine und dergleichen singe und mit einer colect beschlossen.

At night, at *Salve* time: that in the stead of the former *Salve*, for a blessing before sleep, the schoolmaster with his boys sing a German song of praise, as the litany, or "In the midst of life we are," or *Da pacem Domine*, and the like, and conclude with a collect.

The Hohenlohe order of 1553 abolished the *Salve Regina* outright, "because it is flat against God's word and the honour of Christ" (Sehling 15, p. 74):

> Vom Salve Das Salve regina celi etc., so bißher gesungen worden, dieweyl es Gottes wort und der ehr Christi stracks zuwider, soll aller cüng abgetonn.

Of the *Salve*. The *Salve regina coeli*, etc., which hath hitherto been sung, because it is flat against God's word and the honour of Christ, shall be wholly done away.

In the Kraichgau order of Neckarbischofsheim it stayed, "turned upon Christ and put into German". **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 672):

> darauf singt der Schulmaister das magnificat teusch Luc. 1. Darauf folgt das Salve Regina coeli, uf Christum gezogen und verteuscht.

thereupon the schoolmaster singeth the Magnificat in German, Luke 1. Thereupon followeth the *Salve Regina coeli*, turned upon Christ and put into German.

### 8.16.6 The catechism service: the hymn of the chief part

The catechism service chose its hymn by the chief part being taught. This is the clearest case in the corpus of a hymn chosen by its doctrine, and it is nearly universal:

| Chief part | Hymn |
|---|---|
| Ten Commandments | "Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot"; "Mensch, willst du leben seliglich" |
| Creed | "Wir glauben all"; "Ich glaub an Gott" |
| Lord's Prayer | "Vater unser im Himmelreich" |
| Baptism | "Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam" |
| Lord's Supper | "Jesus Christus unser Heiland"; "Gott sei gelobet" |
| Keys / Confession | "Aus tiefer Not"; "Erbarm dich mein"; "So wahr ich leb" |

**Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 386):

> Darauff singe die Kirche auch einen Christlichen deutschen Psalm, dem Artickel des Catechismi, so deßmals Tractirt, gemeß, Als Bey der Erklerung des Decalogi: Die Zehen Gebott, Item: Mensch, wiltu leben seeliglich etc., Des Symboli: Den Glauben und andere darzu dienliche Psalm, Des Vater unsers: Vater unser, der du bist im Himmel, leret uns Jhesus Christ; Item: Vater unser im Himelreich, Der Heiligen Tauffe: Durch Adams fall Und: Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam etc., Des Hochwirdigen Sacraments des Altars: Was kan uns kommen an für not, Item: Jhesus Christus, unser Heilandt, Damit die Gesenge, darinnen die Heilige Göttliche schrifft mit schönen, runden Worten zusammengefasset, den Ungelerten und Jungen Leuten bekant und gemein werden.

Thereupon let the church also sing a Christian German psalm agreeable to the article of the catechism then treated: as at the exposition of the Decalogue, "The Ten Commandments," item "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; of the creed, "The Creed" and other psalms serving thereto; of the Our Father, "Our Father, who art in heaven, as Jesus Christ teacheth us," item "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; of holy baptism, "Through Adam's fall," and "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc.; of the most worthy sacrament of the altar, "What need can come upon us," item "Jesus Christ our Saviour": that the songs, wherein the holy divine Scripture is summed up in fair round words, may become known and common to the unlearned and young folk.

Grubenhagen kept the same hymn for as long as the one chief part was being taught. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1046):

> Hierbey kan man auch allezeit etwas singen, das sich auf das stück des catechismi reimet, welchs erkleret worden, als, wenn man die zehen gebot ausleget und solang man damit umbgehet, kan man singen: Diss sind die heiligen zehen gebot etc., oder: Mensch, wiltu leben seliglich etc., und also fortan mit den andern, damit das junge volk die christlichen, geistreichen gesenge, die ihnen oft eine gute auslegung und herrlich liecht geben, auch im gedechtnis und herzen tiefer haften, mögen fassen.

Herewith one can also always sing something that rhymeth with the part of the catechism that hath been expounded: as when the Ten Commandments are expounded, and as long as one is busied therewith, one can sing "These are the holy ten commandments," etc., or "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; and so forth with the others; that the young folk may grasp the Christian, spiritual songs, which often give them a good exposition and glorious light, and that they may cleave the deeper in memory and heart.

A Henneberg pastor did the same. **Queienfeld (Henneberg), pastor's report, 1566** (Sehling 2, pp. 344–345):

> Singen erstlichen im anfang die zehen gepot, so lang man leret von den zehen gepoten und darnach von den dreien heubtartikel des glaubens, so lang man auch […] davon predigt, und also fortan bis zu ende des catechismi.

[We] sing first at the beginning the Ten Commandments, as long as the Ten Commandments are taught; and thereafter [the hymn] of the three chief articles of the creed, as long as that also is preached; and so forth to the end of the catechism.

In the Hoya villages the catechism service opened with Speratus's "Nun lasst uns Christen fröhlich sein", and then took the hymn of each chief part. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

> anfahen, einen psalm zu singen von dem catechismo, welcher in dem psalmbüchlein gefunden wird und heist Nu last uns Christen frölich sein etc. Darnach, in der verhandlung des decalogi, singet man Diß sind die heiligen zehen gebot. In der tractation des glaubens singet man Wir gleuben. Uber dem Vater unser singet man Vater unser im himelreich. Uber der lehr von der taufe singet man Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam; in der verhandlung des nachtmals Jhesus Christus, unser heyland; auch zu zeiten andere feine lutherische psalmen, auf das die leute einen psalm nach dem andern lernen sin[gen].

[they shall] begin to sing a psalm of the catechism, which is found in the psalm book and is called "Now let us Christians be joyful," etc. Thereafter, in the treating of the Decalogue, one singeth "These are the holy ten commandments"; in the treating of the creed, "We believe"; over the Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven"; over the teaching of baptism, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came"; in the treating of the Supper, "Jesus Christ our Saviour"; and at times also other fine Lutheran psalms, that the people may learn to sing one psalm after another.

Hohenlohe opened the catechism "with a song of that chief part which the pastor has in hand to treat" (Sehling 15, p. 654):

> Es soll auch der catechismus mit einem gesang angefangen werden von demjenigen hauptstuck, so der pfarrherr zu tractieren fürhanden.

The catechism also shall be begun with a song of that chief part which the pastor hath in hand to treat.

The Kurland order taught the Latvian peasants the catechism hymns first, one before and one after, "until the un-German people can learn and profit more". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 91):

> Es sollen aber für allen andern psalmen sich die undeutschen pfarherren der ordnung des catechismi befleissigen und den leuten singen leren. 1. Die zehen gebot, Dis sind die heiligen zehen gebot. 2. Den glauben, Wir gleuben all einen gott. 3. Das vater unser, Vater unser im himmelreich. 4. Die taufe, Christ, unser herr, zum Jordan kam. 5. Das sacrament des altars, Jesus Christus, unser heiland. Gott sei gelobet. 6. Das gloria. Allein gott in der höhe sei ehr. Dis sollen sie ersten nacheinander, das eine stücke für, das ander nach, singen leren, und in den gebrauch bringen, bis das undeutsch v[olk mehr lernen und proficirn mag].

But the pastors of the un-German [the Latvians] shall, before all other psalms, apply themselves to the order of the catechism and teach the people to sing: 1. The Ten Commandments, "These are the holy ten commandments." 2. The creed, "We all believe in one God." 3. The Our Father, "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven." 4. Baptism, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came." 5. The sacrament of the altar, "Jesus Christ our Saviour," "God be praised." 6. The Gloria, "To God alone on high be glory." These they shall first teach them to sing one after another, the one piece before, the other after, and bring them into use, until the un-German people may learn and profit more.

Wertheim calls "Nun freut euch" a good paraphrase of the whole creed. **Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555** (Sehling 11, p. 716):

> Das auch der catechismus im schwang gehe, soll man für der predigt singen die zehen gebot, nemblich in schöner paraphrasi darüber. […] Auch so tut das lied: Nun freut euch lieben Christen gemein genugsam verlesung von allen artikeln des glaubens und ist auf den glauben ein gut paraphrasis.

That the catechism also may be in practice, the Ten Commandments shall be sung before the sermon, namely in the fair paraphrase thereof. […] Also the song "Now rejoice, dear Christians all" doeth sufficient rehearsal of all the articles of faith, and is a good paraphrase upon the creed.

The catechism service itself, its hour, length and order, is treated in Chapter 10, §10.10.

### 8.16.7 Weekday services: reusing the Sunday hymn

At Hof, the Wednesday service repeated the hymn of the Sunday before. On Friday the German hymn of the Sunday vespers was sung again. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 429):

> II. Die Mercurii per duos choros plerumque repeti[…]tur cantilena diei dominici vel festi pracedentis. Die Veneris hymnus germanicus ad vespertinas preces praecedentis dominicae vel festi cantatur.

II. On Wednesday the song of the preceding Sunday or feast is for the most part repeated by two choirs. On Friday the German hymn of the evening prayers of the preceding Sunday or feast is sung.

Regensburg sang a German psalm on weekdays "for the people's sake, that the people may learn the same and in time sing along". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 408):

> Das alda erstlich gesungen werd ein psalm oder sünst ein gesang zu teutsch, umbs volks willen, das das volk dieselben lerne und mit der zeit mitsingen müge, darzu sie den sollen in der predigt zuweilen vermanet werden.

That there first be sung a psalm or else a song in German, for the people's sake, that the people may learn the same and in time may sing along; whereto they shall at times be exhorted in the sermon.

In wartime Neuenstein held a daily prayer service at noon. After the prayer it sang one of seven psalm-hymns of trust and defence, in fixed order, "one each day, and no other". **Neuenstein, *Befehle wegen des Gebetsgottesdienstes*, 1588–1594** (Sehling 15, p. 540):

> volgents umgewechselter weiß alweg nach dem gebett diser psalmen einen. als nembhchen: 1. Ein veste burg ist unser Gott etc., 2. Gib fridt zu unser zeit etc., 3. Erhalt unß, Her, bey deinem wort etc. und Verleyhe uns friden gnediglich etc., 4. Wo Gott der Herr nicht bey uns helt etc., 5. Wer Gott nicht mit uns dise zeit etc., 6. Ach Gott, vom himel silie darein etc., 7.

> In dich hab ich gehoffet herr etc. nachsingen laßen und daruf mit dem segen beschheßen, also clas allen tag in der gantzen wochen einer umb den andern in obgesatzter ordnung nach dem gebett und sonst kein anderer gesungen werde.

following that, changing about, always after the prayer [let] one of these psalms be sung after, namely: 1. "A mighty fortress is our God," etc.; 2. "Give peace in our time," etc.; 3. "Keep us, Lord, by thy word," etc., and "Grant us peace graciously," etc.; 4. "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc.; 5. "Were God not with us at this time," etc.; 6. "Ah God, from heaven look down," etc.; 7. "In thee have I hoped, Lord," etc.; and thereupon conclude with the blessing; so that every day in the whole week one after the other in the order set above be sung after the prayer, and no other.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 likewise rotated Lobwasser's Psalms 20, 61 and 79 on the Friday prayer days, the last "because of the present great need of the Turk", "one Friday after the other in order" (Sehling 15, pp. 655–656).

#### 8.16.8 The *Benedicamus*: kept, graded and put into German

The versicle *Benedicamus Domino*, with its response *Deo gratias* or *Deo dicamus gratias*, ended matins and vespers. After Luther's *Formula missae* it also ended the Mass. Some Lutheran sources outside the church orders sing a festal Latin song, such as *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, with the *Benedicamus* or in its stead: a troped or substituted *Benedicamus*. This pass searched the corpus for that practice in three ways:

- every mention of the *Benedicamus* (411 passages);
- the incipits of the medieval *Benedicamus* tropes;
- the incipits of the old festal songs: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus*, *Nunc angelorum gloria*, *Dies est laetitiae*, *Joseph lieber Joseph mein*, *Surrexit Christus hodie*.

The result is this:

- **No order in the corpus prescribes a troped *Benedicamus*.** No order names a *Benedicamus* trope. None puts a festal song inside the versicle, or between versicle and response.
- **The orders keep the *Benedicamus*, grade it by season and put it into German** (this section). **They also let a figured motet or a German hymn take its place** (§8.16.9).
- ***Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs are found, but at other places.** They come after the Magnificat, just before the collect and *Benedicamus*; at the entrance or going out of festal vespers; for the introit; and after the catechism or the sermon (§8.16.10).

If the troped *Benedicamus* was sung in these churches, the orders do not record it. It may have lived in the cantionals that several orders impose (Lossius, Spangenberg; §8.18.6), which are not part of this corpus.

**At the end of the Mass.** Luther put the *Benedicamus* in the place of *Ite missa est*. He allowed the alleluia to be added, and the melodies of the vesper *Benedicamus* to be borrowed. **Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 6):

> Loco ‘Ite missa’ dicatur: ‘Benedicamus domino’, adiecto (ubi et quando placet) alleluia in suis melodiis. Vel ex vespertinis ‘Benedicamus’ mutuentur.

In the stead of *Ite missa* let there be said *Benedicamus Domino*, with alleluia added (where and when it pleaseth) in its own melodies. Or let the *Benedicamus* [melodies] be borrowed from those of vespers.

The first Nürnberg Mass ends "mit dem Benedicamus Domino, dominicaliter", followed by "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (**Nürnberg, *Form und Ordnung einer christlichen Messe*, 1525**, Sehling 11, p. 57).

**In German.** Müntzer's Allstedt offices (Radical Reformation) end every matins with a German *Benedicamus*. It is plain in Advent and the Passion, with a threefold alleluia at Easter. **Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch kirchenampt*, [1523]**, end of Easter matins (Radical Reformation; Sehling 1, p. 491):

> Das benedicamus. […] Last uns gesegnen den herren alleluia alleluia alleluia. Got sei ewiglich dank alleluia alleluia.

The *Benedicamus*. […] Let us bless the Lord, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. God be thanked for ever, alleluia, alleluia.

The Advent form is on p. 475 and the Passion form on p. 485. Müntzer's *Deutsch evangelisch messe* of 1524 (Radical Reformation) ends each Mass with the same words (Sehling 1, pp. 501–503), and so does the Erfurt *Deutsches Kirchenamt* of 1525 (Sehling 2, pp. 376, 380). In Franconia the German form closed the Mass after the thanksgiving collect. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 330):

> Darnach spricht der priester: Laßt uns gebenedeien den Herrn! antwort das volk: Gott sei gelobet! mit volgendem segen, wie in der ordnung verfast.

After that the priest saith: "Let us bless the Lord!" The people answereth: "God be praised!" with the blessing following, as it is set down in the order.

Hof printed a melody for it. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 426):

> Deinde addit diaconus Benedicamus germanicum, hac melodia observata. […] Last uns gebenedeien den Herren. Chorus: Gott sei gedankt.

Then the deacon addeth the German *Benedicamus*, this melody being kept. […] "Let us bless the Lord." Choir: "God be thanked."

The Wolfenbüttel convents might close their hours "mit dem Benedicamus deudsch oder lateinisch" (**Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569**, Sehling 6/1, p. 261).

**Graded by season.** Like the Kyrie and the Sanctus (§§8.6, 8.12), the *Benedicamus* had its own melodies for the seasons and ranks. They were named after the Latin chants: *in adventu*, *angelicum*, *dominicale*, *paschale*, *festivale*, *feriale*. Hof gives the fullest scheme, with notes, in its register of vespers. The rule comes first. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

> IX. Benedicamus Domino; de tempore, bini vel terni pueri: Deo dicamus gratias: totus chorus vel choraliter vel figuraliter.

IX. *Benedicamus Domino*, of the season, [sung by] two or three boys; *Deo dicamus gratias*, the whole choir, either in plainsong or in figured music.

The grades then follow:

- *in adventu* (p. 412);
- *angelicum* at Christmas (p. 412), which Sehling notes is the name of a melody;
- *dominicale* from Septuagesima to Easter (p. 414), and again from the fifth Sunday after Trinity (p. 420);
- two Easter forms with a threefold alleluia (p. 417);
- the Pentecost form with alleluia (p. 419);
- *festivale seu feriale* (p. 422).

The Easter forms are these (Sehling 11, p. 417):

> Benedicamus paschale primum: [Noten] Benedicamus Domino | Alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. Deo dicamus gratias | [Ende der Noten]. […] Haec per vices cani solent.

The first Easter *Benedicamus*: *Benedicamus Domino*, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. *Deo dicamus gratias*. […] These are wont to be sung by turns.

The northern orders name the grade without the notes. Pomerania closes Sunday matins so. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 437):

> Dar up lest de capellan eine collecte, unde dat chor singet benedicamus domino, dominicale vel de tempore.

Thereupon the chaplain readeth a collect, and the choir singeth *Benedicamus Domino*, the Sunday [melody] or [that] of the season.

- At Lübeck two children sang the *benedicamus dominicale* after the collect (**Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531**, Sehling 5, pp. 348, 351).
- At Lüneburg, when the thanksgiving day of 1575 fell on a Sunday, morning prayer ended with the *Benedicamus angelicum*. Sehling's note calls it especially elaborate (**Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575**, Sehling 6/1, p. 663).

**The long melodies rejected.** Neuenrade printed the plain and the Easter forms. It dropped the long melismatic ones, for they had "few words and [little] devotion". **Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 22, p. 540):

> Benedicamus Domino. Deo dicamus gratias. Benedicamus Domino, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. Deo dicamus gratias, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. De Benedicamus mit den velen noten sal man bliven laten, wente se maken veel geschreies und hebben wenig worde und andacht.

*Benedicamus Domino. Deo dicamus gratias. Benedicamus Domino*, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. *Deo dicamus gratias*, alleluia, alleluia, alleluia. The *Benedicamus* with the many notes shall be let alone, for they make much crying, and have few words and [little] devotion.

The *Benedicamus* as the dismissal of the Mass is treated in Chapter 2, §2.13.1.

### 8.16.9 The *Benedicamus* replaced: motets and German hymns

**Motets.** Where figured music was sung, Hof let a motet stand in the place of the *Benedicamus*. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

> NB. In figurali tamen cantu motecta (nos mutetam vocamus) aliqua conveniente loco Benedicamus concluduntur preces vespertinae.

N.B. In figured music, however, the evening prayers are concluded with some fitting motet (we call it a *mutet*) in the stead of the *Benedicamus*.

Hof's calendar of figured music for the chief feasts names the motets. The text of each belongs to the feast:

- the eve of Advent: *Jerusalem plantabis vineam* (Lasso, for 5 voices) (p. 456);
- Christmas Eve: *Angelus ad pastores ait* (Lasso, for 5) (p. 457);
- the eve of the Circumcision: *Postquam consummati sunt dies octo* (Joachim a Burck, for 5) (p. 458);
- the eve of the Epiphany: *Videntes stellam* (Lasso, for 5) (p. 458);
- the eve of the Annunciation: *Speremus meliora omnes* (Wert, for 5) (p. 460);
- the eve of the Ascension: *Tempus est ut revertar* (Lasso, for 6) (p. 462).

The plainsong *Benedicamus* of the grade stays as the alternative. Christmas Eve reads so (Sehling 11, p. 457):

> Magnificat quinti toni. A 5. Orlandi. Benedicamus angelicum infra [nicht abgedruckt!] notatum, vel loco ejus: Angelus ad pastores ait. A 5. Orlandi.

Magnificat of the fifth tone, for 5, of Orlando. The *Benedicamus angelicum* noted below [not printed!], or in its stead: *Angelus ad pastores ait*, for 5, of Orlando.

**German hymns in its place.** Ostfriesland allowed a German psalm for the *Benedicamus* at both vespers and matins. **Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 7/1, p. 380):

> Und darna synge man Magnificat myt eynen christlicken antiffen ut godtlicker scrift myt eyner christlicken collecten, to latyn offt to duedsche, darna dat Benedicamus effte an syn stadt eyn duedschen psalm.

And thereafter let one sing the Magnificat with a Christian antiphon out of godly Scripture, with a Christian collect, in Latin or in German; thereafter the *Benedicamus*, or in its stead a German psalm.

At Christmas the hymn in its place was "Dank sagen wir alle", the German form of the Christmas sequence *Grates nunc omnes* (§8.8.3). Nördlingen used it in the festal service held in place of matins. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 321):

> 6. Darauf versikel und collect vom fest, aus dem gesangbuechlin Lutheri. 7. Zum beschluß Danksagen wir alle zu Weihnachten, sonsten das Benedicamus.

6. Thereupon the versicle and collect of the feast, out of Luther's little songbook. 7. For the close, "Thanks say we all" at Christmas; otherwise the *Benedicamus*.

The Wolfenbüttel convents made the same choice at morning prayer, all the year round. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 260–261):

> darauf eine reine […] collect deudsch oder lateinisch singen und letzlich mit dem Benedicamus oder Danksagen wir alle etc. beschliessen.

thereupon sing a pure collect in German or Latin, and lastly conclude with the *Benedicamus* or "Thanks say we all," etc.

- Pfalz-Zweibrücken closed both the morning and the afternoon service of Christmas Day with "Conclussio: Danckh sagen wir" (§8.16.10; Sehling 18, p. 340).
- Hof closed its Christmas matins, after the German collect, with a *Leise* in the place of the conclusion. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 413):

> Last uns bitten etc. Conclusionis loco canitur: Ein kindelein so löbelich, vel: Gelobet seistu, Jesu Christ, cum versu ultimo Das hat er alles uns getan.

"Let us pray," etc. In the place of the conclusion is sung "A little Child so worthy of praise," or "Praised be thou, Jesu Christ," with the last verse, "All this hath he done for us."

In the Neumark the Königsberg order of 1586, printed by Sehling only in extract, had "Verleih uns Frieden" sung instead of the Latin *Benedicamus* after the lessons and the weekday sermons (Sehling 3, pp. 236–237).

**German hymns after it.** More often the *Benedicamus* stayed, and a German hymn followed it. In Pomerania this was the prayer for peace, sung kneeling. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

> Dar na lest de prester eine collecte düdisch edder latinisch, unde beslüt dat chor mit dem benedicamus, unde singet dar up, da pacem domine, flexis genibus, latinisch edder düdisch.

After that the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir concludeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem Domine* on bended knees, in Latin or German.

At Regensburg it was a penitential psalm. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 461):

> Nach dem Magnificat singt der diaconus ein deudsche collecten, darauf etliche knaben, für dem altar knieend, Benedicamus Domino und der chor: Deo gratias und fort ein deudschen psalmum poenitentialem, das Miserere oder De profundis, Erbarm dich mein usw., O Herre Gott, begnade mich. Aus tiefer not oder Durch Adams fall usw.

After the Magnificat the deacon singeth a German collect; thereupon certain boys, kneeling before the altar, [sing] *Benedicamus Domino*, and the choir *Deo gratias*; and forthwith a German penitential psalm, the *Miserere* or *De profundis*: "Have mercy on me," etc., "O Lord God, be gracious to me," "Out of deep need," or "Through Adam's fall," etc.

The Wolfenbüttel village vespers followed it with "Erhalt uns, Herr, bey deinem wort" (Sehling 6/1, p. 154). The Nürnberg Mass of 1525 followed it with "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (above).

### 8.16.10 *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the festal songs

The old Latin songs of the feasts were kept in the schools, often "latin unde düdesch". They were sung in Latin by the scholars and in German by the girls or the people, verse about. The corpus puts them at four places. None of these is the *Benedicamus* itself.

**After the Magnificat.** At Naumburg the ordinary Sunday vespers ended with the Magnificat and its antiphon, "or else a short song of the season", and then the collect and *Benedicamus*. **Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

> 6. Das magnificat mit seiner antiphon, Christus unser heiland, oder sonst ein kurz gsang nach der zeit und haben zue diesem mal drei ton sextum, septimum et peregrinum. 7. Darnach concludirt man mit der collecten und benedicamus.

6. The Magnificat with its antiphon, "Christ our Saviour," or else a short song according to the season; and they have at this time three tones, the sixth, the seventh and the *peregrinus*. 7. After that one concludeth with the collect and *Benedicamus*.

At Christmas that short song was *Puer natus in Bethlehem* or one of its fellows (Sehling 2, p. 76):

> Zur vesper. Christum wir sollen loben schon, vor der predigt. Magnificat sexti toni nach der predigt. Auf das magnificat, In dulci jubilo oder Vom himmel hoch oder Puer natus in Bethlehem. Dergleichen helt man es auch circumcisionis, epiphanae und purificationis.

At vespers: "Christ we should praise fair," before the sermon; the Magnificat of the sixth tone after the sermon; upon the Magnificat, *In dulci jubilo*, or "From heaven high," or *Puer natus in Bethlehem*. The like is kept also at the Circumcision, the Epiphany and the Purification.

Nördlingen copied the passage word for word in 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 321). This is the nearest the corpus comes to *Puer natus* at the *Benedicamus*. It is the last chant before the collect and the *Benedicamus*, in the place of the Magnificat antiphon, but it does not replace or trope the *Benedicamus*. At Brieg the Christmas song was joined to the Magnificat itself. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 445):

> darauf die predigt, nach gehaltener predigt das Magnificat resonet in Laudibus, und mit dem Benedicamus beschlossen.

thereupon the sermon; after the sermon is held, the Magnificat [with] *Resonet in laudibus*; and concluded with the *Benedicamus*.

The order does not say whether *Resonet* was sung between the verses of the Magnificat or after it. Either way the *Benedicamus* follows unchanged.

**At the entrance and the going out.** The Pomeranian *Agenda* let the schoolmaster choose *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus* or *Nunc angelorum gloria* "pro ingressu vel egressu" at Christmas vespers (§8.16.2; Sehling 4, p. 435). Sung for the going out, such a song came after the *Benedicamus* and *Da pacem* (§8.16.9). At Hof the three days of Christmas vespers opened with a different Latin song each day, with the German sung alongside. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 433):

> Vesperi. Primo die: In natali Domini. Secundo: Parvulus nobis nascitur. Tertio: Puer natus in Bethlehem quatuor vocum, ita ut latinum scholastici :germanicum puella cantent. Deinde subiungatur hymnus: Christum wir sollen loben schon.

At vespers. On the first day, *In natali Domini*; on the second, *Parvulus nobis nascitur*; on the third, *Puer natus in Bethlehem* in four voices, so that the scholars sing the Latin, the girls the German. Then let the hymn "Christ we should praise fair" be joined to it.

Epiphany vespers began the same way ("Initio: Puer natus in Bethlehem: A 4", p. 434). Hof's calendar of figured music puts the song at the moment the scholars came into the church, and does the same at Easter (Sehling 11, pp. 458, 461):

> Vesperi. Intrantibus scholasticis in templum canitur: Puer natus in Bethlehem A 4, ita ut puellae germanicos versus accinant.

At vespers. As the scholars enter the church, *Puer natus in Bethlehem* is sung for 4, so that the girls sing the German verses to it.

> Vesperi. Inter introeundum, primo anno: Surrexit Christus hodie, A 4, secundo: surrexit Christus Dominus, A4, quibus germanica puellae addunt.

At vespers. While they go in, in the first year *Surrexit Christus hodie*, for 4; in the second, *Surrexit Christus Dominus*, for 4; to which the girls add the German.

**In the school.** The Pomeranian order made the children learn these songs. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, pp. 401–402):

> Item, de olden cantica van den festen. Up winachten. Puer natus in Bethlehem, latin unde düdesch. Nunc angelorum gloria. Resonet in laudibus. Joseph lever Joseph min. In dulci iubilo. Dies est, laetitiae. […] Up paschen. Surrexit Christus hodie, mit dem düdeschen : Erstanden is de hilige christ etc. Up pingesten. Spiritus sancti gratia, latin unde düdesch, unde wat der geliken olde gesenge mer sint, de schölen den kindern vlitich geleret werden.

Item, the old songs of the feasts. At Christmas: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*, Latin and German; *Nunc angelorum gloria*; *Resonet in laudibus*; "Joseph, dear Joseph mine"; *In dulci jubilo*; *Dies est laetitiae*. […] At Easter: *Surrexit Christus hodie*, with the German

"Arisen is the holy Christ," etc. At Pentecost: *Spiritus sancti gratia*, Latin and German. And whatever other old songs there are of the like, these shall be diligently taught to the children.

The Lüneburg convent orders also name *Puer natus*, *In dulci jubilo* and *Dies est laetitiae* among the "christliche gesenge" of the high feasts (Sehling 6/1, pp. 614, 621).

**For the introit, and after the catechism or sermon.** At Sulzfeld (1566) the choir sang "Ein Kind geboren zu Bethlehem" in the place of the Christmas introit (§8.5). A late Bischofswerda order, printed from a letter of the council to the cantor of 1676, opens every Sunday with a song of the season "zum introitu". **Bischofswerda, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*** (Sehling 2, p. 106):

> 1. Zum introitu im advent: Nun komm' der heiden heiland. Weihnacht: Puer natus in Bethlehem. Fastnacht: Christus, der uns etc. Ostern: Surrexit Christus etc. Pfingsten : Spiritus s. gratia. Trinitatis: Gott der vater wohn etc.

1. For the introit: in Advent, "Now come, the Saviour of the heathen"; at Christmas, *Puer natus in Bethlehem*; at Shrovetide, "Christ, who [maketh] us," etc.; at Easter, *Surrexit Christus*, etc.; at Pentecost, *Spiritus sancti gratia*; at Trinity, "God the Father dwell [with us]," etc.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken spread the Christmas songs over the afternoon service. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 1565** (Sehling 18, p. 340):

> Nachmittag. Introitus: Von himel hoch, da kham ich her etc. Gelobet seistu etc. Post Catechismum: Puer natus in Betlehem. Post Concionem: In dulci iubilo. Conclussio: Danckh sagen wir etc.

Afternoon. Introit: "From heaven high, there came I here," etc.; "Praised be thou," etc. After the catechism: *Puer natus in Bethlehem*. After the sermon: *In dulci jubilo*. Close: "Thanks say we," etc.

At Hof the Christmas weekday services put *In dulci jubilo*, *Resonet in laudibus* and *Nunc angelorum gloria* before or after the sermon. They were sung "wechsels weis", Latin and German by turns (Sehling 11, pp. 433–434).

**Summary.**

- The *Benedicamus* was kept as a short versicle and response. Its melody was graded by season: *in adventu*, *angelicum* at Christmas, *dominicale*, and with alleluia at Easter and Pentecost.
- Where it was enlarged, this was done in two ways. Figured music could put a motet of the feast "loco Benedicamus". A German hymn could take its place, at Christmas "Dank sagen wir alle". Neither is a trope inside the *Benedicamus*.
- *Puer natus in Bethlehem* and the other festal songs stood next to the *Benedicamus*, not in it. They came upon the Magnificat, at the entrance or going out of vespers, for the introit, and after the catechism or sermon, with Latin and German verses alternating.
- The one judgement on the long *Benedicamus* melodies in the corpus rejects them (Neuenrade 1564).

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## 8.17 Hymns at the occasional rites

The rites outside the Sunday service had their own small sets of hymns. Each rite drew on a fixed handful. The choice within the handful was left to the pastor or schoolmaster, or to the family's wishes and purse.

| Rite | Hymns named |
|---|---|
| Baptism | "Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam"; "Vater unser"; stanzas of "Durch Adams Fall"; "Herr, schaff uns wie die kleinen Kind" |
| Wedding | Ps 128 "Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht"; Ps 127 "Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst"; "Nun bitten"; Te Deum; "Dein Eh sollst du bewahren rein" (the sixth commandment) |
| The sick and dying | "Aus tiefer Not"; "Mit Fried und Freud"; "Nun freut euch"; the baptism and communion hymns |
| Burial | "Mitten wir im Leben sind" (with or after *Media vita*); "Mit Fried und Freud"; "Aus tiefer Not"; "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben"; "Wir glauben all"; *Si bona suscepimus*; *Jam moesta quiesce* |

| Rite | Hymns named |
|---|---|
| Ordination and installation | "Nun bitten" or "Komm heiliger Geist"; "Wir glauben"; Te Deum or "Dank sagen wir alle"; *Veni creator*; *Veni sancte Spiritus* |
| Thanksgiving days | Te Deum; Ps 124 "Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält"; Ps 127 |

The rites themselves are treated in Chapter 13: baptism in §13.3, marriage in §13.7, the sick in §13.8, burial in §13.9, and ordination and installation in §§13.10–13.11.

### 8.17.1 Baptism

Hof gives a reason for singing at baptism at all: so that two actions do not follow each other without a song, with an unaccustomed silence between them. Before a baptism at the weekday service, the hymn stanza sung was the one that matched the catechism lesson just read. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

> soll nach geendter lection zu den festen und sontägen zur vesper (nun mehr stracks nach der predigt) etwas gesungen werden, uf das nicht zwen actus ohne ein gesang, ufeinander folgen und ein ungewöhnlich stillschweigen sich dazwischen zutrage. Und weil man an den zehen geboten lieset, soll allweg dasselbig gebot aus den lengeren zehen geboten gesungen werden, von welchem in gedachter lection gehandelt worden. Weil man an dem glauben lieset, soll bei dem ersten artikel gesungen werden: Gott der Vater wohn uns bei, bei dem andern: Jesus Christus wohn uns bei, bei dem dritten: Heiliger Geiste wohn uns bei etc. Weil man von dem Vaterunser lieset, soll zu einer iden bit ein gesetz aus dem Vaterunser doctoris Martini gesungen werden. Wann von der tauf gelesen wird, soll gesungen werden das gesetz aus dem gesang Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam, so die ordnung der erklerung mit sich bringt. Wann man vom ambt der schlüssel oder absolution lieset, soll gesungen werden: So war ich leb.

after the lesson is ended, on the feasts and Sundays at vespers (now straightway after the sermon), something shall be sung, that two actions may not follow one upon the other without a song, and an unaccustomed silence fall between. And while the Ten Commandments are being read, that same commandment out of the longer Ten Commandments shall always be sung which was treated in the said lesson. While the creed is being read, at the first article shall be sung "God the Father be with us"; at the second, "Jesus Christ be with us"; at the third, "Holy Ghost be with us," etc. While the Our Father is being read, to every petition a stanza out of Doctor Martin's Our Father shall be sung. When baptism is read of, that stanza out of the song "Christ our Lord to Jordan came" shall be sung which the order of the exposition bringeth with it. When the office of the keys or absolution is read of, "As truly as I live" shall be sung.

Through the rest of the year the baptism hymn ran on from one baptism to the next. One stanza was sung before the baptism and the next after it, and when the hymn was finished it began again (Sehling 11, p. 431):

> Hernach durchs ganze jahr: Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam, (ein gesetz vor, das andere nach der tauf und, wann es aus ist, widerumb forne angehaben). Zum beschlus des actus diurni mag man bisweilen die ubrigen gesetz an diesem gesang bis zum end singen.

Thereafter through the whole year, "Christ our Lord to Jordan came" (one stanza before, the next after the baptism, and when it is out, begun again from the front). At the close of the daily service one may at times sing the remaining stanzas of this song to the end.

**Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 628):

> So soll der Schulmeister erstlich einen Tauffgesang singen, Als: Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam, oder: Herr, schaff uns wie die kleinen Kind etc.

Then the schoolmaster shall first sing a baptismal song, as "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," or "Lord, make us as the little children," etc.

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 236):

> Bei der taufe pfleget man an etlichen orten auf dem lande zu singen. Vater unser im himmelreich. Oder. Christ unser herr zum Jordan kam. Oder. Etliche vers aus dem gesange, Durch Adams fall ist ganz verderbt etc.

At baptism it is the custom in some places in the country to sing "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," or "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," or some verses out of the song "Through Adam's fall is all corrupt," etc.

**Cochstedt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 2, p. 484):

> Zur taufe wird gesungen durch die schüler: Christ unser herr zum Jordan.

At baptism the scholars sing "Christ our Lord to Jordan."

In Lüneburg, children were baptized between the epistle and the gospel of the Sunday Mass. The litany-hymn "Nim von uns" was then left out (§8.8.9).

### 8.17.2 Weddings

The wedding psalms were Psalm 127 and Psalm 128, in their metrical forms. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539**, variants (Sehling 1, p. 274):

> Erstlich, das man singe den 127. psalm, oder den 128. Nach dem psalmen sol eine lectio aus eim evangelisten, oder S. Paulus episteln einer gelesen werden, die hiezu dienet, als nemlich, das evangelium Johannis am 2. capitel, es ward ein hochzeit zu Cana in Galilea etc. item zun Ephesern am 5. capitel, oder dergleichen. Darnach singe man, nu bitten wir den heiligen geist.

First, that the hundred and twenty-seventh psalm be sung, or the hundred and twenty-eighth. After the psalm a lesson shall be read out of one of the evangelists or of St Paul's epistles that serveth hereto, namely the gospel of John in the second chapter, "There was a marriage in Cana of Galilee," etc., item to the Ephesians in the fifth chapter, or the like. Thereafter let "Now pray we the Holy Ghost" be sung.

**Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 632):

> Vor der Predigt soll man den 127. Psalmen: Wo Gott der Herr nicht gibt sein gunst etc. unnd den Christlichen Glauben singen. Darauff folget die Predigt mit dem Gebett, wie sonst die gewöhnlichen Wochenpredigt gehalten werden. Nach gehaltener Predigt singt man den 128. Psalmen: Wol dem, der in Gottes Forchte stehet etc.

Before the sermon shall be sung the hundred and twenty-seventh psalm, "Where God the Lord giveth not his favour," etc., and the Christian creed. Thereupon followeth the sermon with the prayer, as the customary weekday sermons are otherwise held. After the sermon is held, the hundred and twenty-eighth psalm is sung, "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.

In Hof, and in the Henneberg village of Goldlauter, the sixth commandment was sung after the marriage, from Luther's Ten Commandments hymn, with its last stanza. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

> vor der copulation gesungen: Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht, post copulationem: Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein etc. oder aber: Dein eh soltu bewahren rein ex decalogo germanico Lutheri addito ultimo Das helf uns der Herr Jesu Christ.

before the marriage is sung "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear"; after the marriage, "Where God to the house giveth not his," etc., or else "Thy marriage shalt thou keep pure," out of Luther's German Decalogue, with the last [stanza] added, "Help us to this, Lord Jesu Christ."

**Goldlauter (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 333):

> so pfleg man erstlich zu singen das Veni sancte in kurzer melodei und halt darauf Ein feste burg und darnach den glauben, unterdes gehen die leut zum opfer. Demnach thue ich ein hochzeitpredigt auf der canzel. Nach der predigt singt man: Wol dem der in gottes furchten stehet und werden beide eheleut […] zusamen gegeben […] Zum beschluss singt man wider das sechste gebot: Dein ehe soltu bewaren rein, und Das helfe uns der herr Jesus Christ.

then it is the custom first to sing the *Veni sancte* in the short melody, and thereupon "A mighty fortress," and thereafter the creed; meanwhile the people go to the offering. Then I hold a wedding sermon in the pulpit. After the sermon is sung "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," and both spouses are joined together […]. At the close is sung again the sixth commandment, "Thy marriage shalt thou keep pure," and "Help us to this, the Lord Jesus Christ."

Osnabrück sang the German or Latin Te Deum and Psalm 128 before the bridal Mass. **Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 225):

> Und so de brudt worde tor kercken gahn, soll men vor der brudtmisse singen: Te Deum laudamus dudesch effte latein und den psalm Woll dem, de in Gades fruchten steit etc.

And when the bride goeth to church, there shall be sung before the bridal Mass the *Te Deum laudamus* in German or Latin, and the psalm "Blessed is he that standeth in God's fear," etc.

In Hamburg the families could hire the organist and cantor for more. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 516):

> Dar machme denne in der karcken up den orgelen spelen und singen mit den scholeren Te deum laudamus, edder wat anders van gade, edder ock in figurativis etc., wo de lude idt denne mit dem organisten und cantoren vor ohre drankgelt hebben bestellet.

There one may then in the church play upon the organs and sing with the scholars *Te Deum laudamus*, or something else of God, or also in figured music, etc., as the folk have then ordered it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money.

Hohenlohe gave a wedding set for weekday weddings. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 656):

> Zun hochzeiten in der wochen Fur der predigt soll gesungen werden: Nun welche hie etc., Es sind doch seelig alle, die etc. Nach der predigt für der eheeinleitung: Es woll uns Gott genädig sein etc. oder ein Gloria. Nach einleitung der ehe: Woll dem, der in Gottes forcht etc.

At weddings in the week: before the sermon shall be sung "Now they that here," etc., "Blessed are all they that," etc.; after the sermon, before the marriage, "May God be gracious unto us," etc., or a Gloria; after the marriage, "Blessed is he that in God's fear," etc.

#### 8.17.3 The sick and the dying

The Regensburg order gives a short list of hymns for those who attended the dying: "grounded psalms and songs", not "old erroneous prayers and sayings". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 410):

> inen das vaterunser und den glauben fürsprechen und, wus zeit hat, gegründete psalm und geseng, als: Aus tiefer not schrei ich zu dir etc., In fried und freud ich far dahin, Nun freut euch, lieben christen gemein, von der tauf, vom sacrament des leibs und bluts etc., nicht alte, irrige gebet und spruch.

[they shall] say the Our Father and the creed before them, and, where there is time, grounded psalms and songs, as "Out of the depths I cry to thee," etc., "In peace and joy I now depart," "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," [the songs] of baptism, of the sacrament of the body and blood, etc.; not old, erroneous prayers and sayings.

#### 8.17.4 Burial

The burial hymn named first everywhere is Luther's "Mitten wir im Leben sind", often after the Latin *Media vita*. The Saxon Visitation Articles of 1528 already ask for it. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 170):

> und bei dem begrebnis, das deudsche gesang, mitten in dem leben, singen lassen.

and at the burial let the German song "In the midst of life" be sung.

Brandenburg sets the hymns by the course of the procession: "Mitten wir im Leben" on the way, "Aus tiefer Not" if the way was long, and Simeon's song on the return to church. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

> so man die leiche tregt, mag man singen, media vita und die drei deutsche vers, mitten wir im leben sind, und so der weg zu lang, das deudsche deprofundis, aus tiefer not, oder sonst das responsorium libera me domine. Und so man vom begrebnis widerum in die kirchen gehet, alsdenn mag man singen, mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin.

when the corpse is carried, one may sing *Media vita* and the three German verses, "In the midst of life we are," and, if the way be too long, the German *De profundis*, "Out of the depths," or else the responsory *Libera me Domine*. And when one goeth again from the burial into the church, then one may sing "In peace and joy I now depart."

Hof adds "Aus tiefer Not" "with the slow melody" when needed, and graded its funerals by the number of school classes that attended. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 475):

> Hinc germanicae sequuntur cantilenae, etiam in particularibus funeribus, quibus tertiani, quartani et quintani, in hieme, ast in aestate etiam sextani intersunt cantore duce, usurpandae videlicet: Mitten wir im leben sind. Gott der Vater wohn uns bei. Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin Lutheri. Item si necessitas postulat, praenotatis, antequam pueri templum d. Laurentii ingressi sunt, finitis adiiciuntur: Aus tiefer not, mit der langsamen melodie zu singen. Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Got.

Hence follow German songs, to be used also at private funerals, at which the third, fourth and fifth classes attend under the cantor's lead in winter, and in summer the sixth also, namely: "In the midst of life we are"; "God the Father be with us"; Luther's "In peace and joy I now depart." Item, if need require, when the aforesaid are finished before the boys have entered St Lawrence's church, there are added "Out of the depths," to be sung with the slow melody, and "Have mercy on me, O Lord God."

Several orders split the burial hymn around the sermon. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 174):

> soll man singen: Nun laßt Uns den Leib begraben etc. biß auff den Verß: Nun lassen wir Ihn hie schlaffen etc. Darauff soll der Kirchendiener Einer, an den es begeret worden, ein Christliche, gebürliche unnd dem gegenwertigen Handel gemäße Leichpredigt thuon.

one shall sing "Now let us bury the body," etc., until the verse "Now let we him sleep here," etc. Thereupon one of the ministers, of whom it hath been desired, shall hold a Christian, fitting funeral sermon, agreeable to the present business.

**Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 623):

> In der Kirchen zu Münster, wan die gemain sich versamblet, eintweder das gesang: Mitten wir im Leben sind etc. wider ganz und nach der Predigt: Nun last uns den leib begraben etc. Oder diß Gesang vor der Predigt biß auff die zwei lezste gesäz: Nun lassen wir ihn hie schlaffen etc. Und dieselbige als dann nach der Predigt.

In the church at Münster, when the congregation assembleth, either the song "In the midst of life we are," etc., again wholly, and after the sermon "Now let us bury the body," etc.; or this song before the sermon until the two last stanzas, "Now let we him sleep here," etc., and the same then after the sermon.

**Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 656):

> In der proceßion hinauß mit der leich biß zum grab und in die kirchen hinein für der predigt soll man singen: Mitten wir im leben etc., Mit fridt und freyd etc., Gott der Vatter wohn uns bey etc., Wenn mein stundlein vorhanden ist etc. Nach der predigt aber soll man bey dem grab singen: Nun last unß den leib etc.

In the procession out with the corpse to the grave, and into the church before the sermon, shall be sung "In the midst of life," etc., "In peace and joy," etc., "God the Father be with us," etc., "When my last hour is come," etc. But after the sermon "Now let us [bury] the body," etc. shall be sung at the grave.

**Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 2, p. 136):

> Als dan wird der cörper in die erde begraben, die schul knaben singen, weil man begrebt, den gesang Lutheri: Nu last uns den leib begraben.

Then the body is buried in the earth; the school boys sing, while it is being buried, Luther's song "Now let us bury the body."

The Kurland order lists the hymns for before the funeral sermon, "as many as it pleaseth". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 105):

> Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin. Erbarme dich meiner, o herre gott. Aus tiefer noth. Mitten wir im leben. Das responsorium. Si bona suscepimus et similia. Ich gleub an gott vater, almechtigen. Wir gleuben. Diese psalmen und gesengen brauchet man so viel für der leichpredigt als gefellig.

"In peace and joy I now depart." "Have mercy on me, O Lord God." "Out of the depths." "In the midst of life." The responsory *Si bona suscepimus* and the like. "I believe in God the Father Almighty." "We believe." These psalms and songs one useth before

the funeral sermon, as many as it pleaseth.

**Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 290):

> Bei den leichen der frommen christen sollen gesungen werden lateinisch und deutesch, si bona suscepimus. Media vita. Scio quod redemptor meus. Mit fried und freud. Aus tiefer not. Erbarm dich meiner. Nu last uns den leib begraben.

At the funerals of godly Christians shall be sung, in Latin and German, *Si bona suscepimus*, *Media vita*, *Scio quod redemptor meus*, "In peace and joy," "Out of the depths," "Have mercy on me," "Now let us bury the body."

The words "of godly Christians" matter. Singing was an honour, and it could be withheld. A later Nürnberg regulation, printed with the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order, forbids the hymns of Christian hope for those who died unrepentant, because of the offence. It gives them the penitential hymns instead. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533**, later appendix (Sehling 11, p. 202):

> denen können die ordentliche lieder: Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin nach Gottes willen etc. und andere dergleichen christliche gesänger, so sich auf solche fälle nicht schicken, für dem haus und im fortgehen, ärgernis zu vermeiden, nicht gesungen werden. Sondern für der tür wäre zu singen: Mitten wir im leben sind etc., in fortgehen aber: So wahr ich lebe, spricht dein Gott etc. item, andere bußlieder.

for these the ordinary songs, "In peace and joy I now depart according to God's will," etc., and other such Christian songs as fit not such cases, cannot be sung before the house and in the going forth, to avoid offence. But before the door there might be sung "In the midst of life we are," etc., and in the going forth, "As truly as I live, saith thy God," etc., item other songs of repentance.

At Strasbourg there was no singing unless it was asked for, and then no funeral sermon either. **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577** (Sehling 20/1, p. 518):

> vor und nach der predigt singt entweder: Mitten wir im leben sind, oder: Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin, item: Nun last uns den leib begraben. Wo es aber nit begert wird, gleich wie man nicht singt, also thut man auch keine leichpredigt.

before and after the sermon is sung either "In the midst of life we are," or "In peace and joy I now depart," item "Now let us bury the body." But where it is not desired, even as one singeth not, so one also holdeth no funeral sermon.

The Leiningen order abolished the old "singing over" the dead with holy water, but allowed the scholars to sing German hymns. **Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 267):

> alles Bäpstisch gepreng mit Weywasser, Besingen und andern etc. abgeschaffen sein. Dann solches nicht allein ohne Gottes wort, sondern auch wider Gottes wort angerichtet, als sol es zur seligkeit fürderlich sein. Wo nun schulen sindt, mögen die schüler wol etliche teutsche Gesang singen, Als: Mitten wir im leben sind, Nun lessest du deinen diener im friede fahren etc.

all popish pomp with holy water, singing over [the dead], and other things, etc. [shall] be done away. For such was set up not only without God's word but also against God's word, as though it should be furthersome to salvation. Now where there are schools, the scholars may well sing some German songs, as "In the midst of life we are," "Now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace," etc.

The Goslar order of 1528 left the whole matter to "a godly, reasonable, learned pastor". **Goslar, Amsdorf, *Vom teglichen gots dinst*, 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 237–238):

> Das eyn caplan, der custer, ouch dy schuller mit gehen, las ich gescheen, und singen deutzsch und lateyn Media vita, eyn psalm etc. Daß alles stehet bey eym frommen, vornunfftigen, gelerten pfarhern zu […] myndern und zu meren, das ehrs orden, wys am besten und nutzten dem volck seyn wirt.

That a chaplain, the sexton and also the scholars go along, I allow to be done, and [that they] sing in German and Latin *Media vita*, a psalm, etc. All this standeth with a godly, reasonable, learned pastor to lessen and to increase, that he order it as it shall be best and most profitable for the people.

#### 8.17.5 Ordination and installation

The ordination and installation rites of the Württemberg family open with "Nun bitten". The creed is sung after the sermon, and the service closes with the Te Deum or the German *Grates*. **Württemberg, *Synodalordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 16, p. 159):

> Unnd so das volgkh inn der kirchen versamlet, soll man annfangen unnd singen: Nun piten wier den hailgen gaist, etc. Uf dis gesanng solle der dechan oder einer der Consiliariis uffsteen unnd ein Predig thun von Ministerio verbi [...] Nach der Predig soll gesungen werdenn der Glaub.

And when the people are assembled in the church, one shall begin and sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc. After this song the dean or one of the councillors shall stand up and hold a sermon of the ministry of the word [...]. After the sermon the creed shall be sung.

Lippe (1571) copies the rite, and the superintendent steps before the altar during the creed (Sehling 21, p. 438):

> so das Volck in der Kirchen versamblet, anfangs singen: Nu bitten wir den Heiligen Geist etc., Auff diß Gesang der Superintendens oder sein Adjunct auffstehen und ein Predigt thun vom Ministerio verbi.

when the people are assembled in the church, [they shall] sing at the beginning "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," etc.; after this song the superintendent or his adjunct [shall] stand up and hold a sermon of the ministry of the word.

**Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 408):

> Das volk sol zuvor in der kirchen vorsamlet, etliche psalmen absingen, und darnach zu letzt darauf folgen: Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist. Oder: Kom heiliger geist, herre gott.

The people, first assembled in the church, shall sing some psalms, and thereafter at the last there shall follow "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," or "Come, Holy Ghost, Lord God."

The Brandenburg installation adds Psalm 67 and the Te Deum. **Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 109):

> nach gesprochenen vater unser sol die gemeine singen: Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, und Es wolt uns gott gnedig sein und seinen segen geben etc., item das te deum laudamus etc.

after the Our Father is spoken the congregation shall sing "Now pray we the Holy Ghost," and "May God be gracious unto us and give his blessing," etc., item the *Te Deum laudamus*, etc.

The Hessian ordination (Philippist) closes with the Te Deum "where there are schools", or "Dank sagen wir alle". **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 455):

> Zum beschluß soll die gemeine singen Te Deum laudamus, teutsch, oder latinisch, wo schulen vorhanden sein, oder Danksagen wir alle, Gott unserm Herrn Christo etc., oder einen andem dergleichen lobgesang.

At the close the congregation shall sing *Te Deum laudamus*, in German, or in Latin where there are schools, or "Thanks say we all to God our Lord Christ," etc., or another such song of praise.

The Merseburg draft for Luther's ordinations has *Veni creator* sung while ordinator and ordinands kneel. **Merseburg, *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545** (Sehling 2, p. 7):

> Credo in unum. Populus: wir glauben. Chor: Veni creator, unter dem der herr ordinator sampt dem ordinanden fur den altar zugleich niederknien solten.

*Credo in unum*. The people: "We believe." The choir: *Veni creator*, during which the lord ordinator together with the ordinands should kneel down together before the altar.

#### 8.17.6 Days of thanksgiving and extraordinary occasions

Michaelmas in Schleswig-Holstein was a harvest thanksgiving, with the Te Deum after the sermon. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

> De dach Michaelis ys eine gemene danckseggínge vor alle fruchte, de wy des Jars gesamlet und entfangen hebben. Darumme schal de gantze vorsamlinge vorth na der predigen singen tho der danckseggínge mit groter andacht: Te Deum Laudamus etc.

The day of Michael is a common thanksgiving for all the fruits which we have gathered and received in the year. Therefore the whole congregation shall, straight after the sermon, sing for the thanksgiving with great devotion *Te Deum Laudamus*, etc.

Lüneburg kept an annual day for the city's deliverance. On it hymns took the place of the propers: Psalm 127 (figural) and Psalm 124 after the epistle, and Psalm 124 again with Psalm 3 at matins. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 663):

> Ad missam: 4. Introitum: Benedicite de angelis, 5. das Kyrie figuraliter, item: Et in terra pax, darnegst: Alleine Godt in der hohe sey ehr, 6. post lectionem epistolae: Nisi Dominus aedificaverit domum, 7. Wo Godt nicht mit uns ist, 8. canitur evangelion, 9. Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist, 10. fit contio sacra, 11. post concionem canitur litania.

At the Mass: 4. the introit *Benedicite* of the angels; 5. the Kyrie in figured music, item *Et in terra pax*, next "To God alone on high be glory"; 6. after the reading of the epistle, *Nisi Dominus aedificaverit domum*; 7. "Were God not with us"; 8. the gospel is sung; 9. "Now pray we the Holy Ghost"; 10. the holy sermon is held; 11. after the sermon the litany is sung.

At Nördlingen's thanksgiving day on 7 January, Psalm 124 could be sung instead of a figured piece, "that the congregation also may have cause to thank God". **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 12, p. 388):

> Singet der chorus ein stuck figuraliter oder, damit die gemein auch Gott zu danken ursach habe, kan der psalm Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns helt etc. gesungen werden.

The choir singeth a piece in figured music; or, that the congregation also may have cause to thank God, the psalm "Where God the Lord standeth not by us," etc. may be sung.

At an execution in Regensburg the crowd sang "Nun bitten" while the condemned man began to recite the creed. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553**, with the order for the condemned (Sehling 13, p. 426):

> Deinde ut palam profiteatur fidem ac recitet symbolum apostolicum: Credo in Deum Patrem etc. Sub illius autem inchoatione cantabit turba circumstans cantilenam: Nun bitten wir den Heilgen Geist.

Then that he openly profess the faith and recite the Apostles' Creed, *Credo in Deum Patrem*, etc. But at the beginning of it the crowd standing about shall sing the song "Now pray we the Holy Ghost."

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## 8.18 How hymns were chosen: the reasons given

The orders seldom explain a single choice. They often state the rules by which choices were to be made. Ten kinds of reason recur. They are gathered here with the quotations not already given in the sections on the slots.

### 8.18.1 From Scripture, and "pure"

The first test is always the text. Anything sung, Latin or German, must come from Scripture or be proved by it. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529**, section "Van singende" (Sehling 5, p. 516):

> Alle singent dudesch und latinsch, wo gesecht, schall ut de hilligen schrift sin, edder mit gades klare worde und dem christliken loven beweret, alse Paulus singen leret, Ephes. 5. Alse ock de olden christene doctores gesungen hebben und singen laten, done me vam salve regina und andere unchristliken sengen nicht wuste.

All singing, German and Latin, as hath been said, shall be out of the holy Scripture, or proved by God's clear words and the Christian faith, as Paul teacheth to sing, Ephesians 5; as also the old Christian doctors sang and caused to be sung, when men knew nothing of the *Salve regina* and other unchristian songs.

Buxtehude applies the test to the Latin chants. It keeps those "agreeable to divine Scripture" and drops the rest. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 77):

> Alle latinische gesenge, godtliker schrift gemete, de wente anher in der kercken in der misse, metten und vesper to besunder tydt gesungen, scholen beholden, gebruket und to ohrer tydt gesungen werden. De averst undenstlick,

> godtliker schrift ungemete unde unrecht, scholen nicht gesungen werden.

All Latin songs agreeable to divine Scripture which have hitherto been sung in the church at Mass, matins and vespers at their special time shall be kept, used and sung at their time. But those that are unserviceable, not agreeable to divine Scripture, and wrong, shall not be sung.

Worms admits hymns as well as psalms, because Paul commended both. But no new hymn is to be brought in without the superintendent and preachers. **Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560** (Sehling 19/1, p. 208):

> Dieweil der heilige Apostel Paulus nicht allein die Psalmen Davids, sondern auch andere Geistliche [...] Lieder und Lobgesäng den Christen hat commendirt und befohlen, So verwerffen wir dieselbigen auch nicht, doch so ferne sie Christlich und inn der Heiligen Schrifft gegründet seien. Allein das man keinen newen Gesang ohne der Supperattendenten und Predicanten rhat und vorwissen inn der Kirchen einführe.

Since the holy apostle Paul hath commended and enjoined to Christians not only the psalms of David but also other spiritual songs and hymns of praise, we also reject them not, yet so far as they be Christian and grounded in holy Scripture. Only that no new song be brought into the church without the counsel and foreknowledge of the superintendents and preachers.

In Württemberg every communion hymn beyond the named ones had to be "examined and admitted" by the superintendents first. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 109):

> oder andere lobgesang, die rein [...] unnd vorhin von den superattendenten besichtiget, examiniert und zugelassen seien.

or other songs of praise which are pure [...] and have been beforehand viewed, examined and admitted by the superintendents.

#### 8.18.2 Fitting the feast and the season

The Saxon Visitation Articles of 1528 thought it "unseemly that the songs are quite alike at all feasts". **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 169):

> Dieweil es auch ein ungestalt ist, das die gesang gar gleich sind an allen festen, were gut, das man an den herrlichsten festen sünge, die lateinische introitus, glor[ia].

Since it is also unseemly that the songs are quite alike at all feasts, it were good that on the most glorious feasts one sang the Latin introits, Gloria [etc.].

Bugenhagen asked the schoolmasters to see that "the songs rhyme finely with the feasts". Where no proper song existed, they were to take "the most joyful psalms or songs". **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 442). The same sentence recurs in Mecklenburg (1545):

> De scholemeystere scholen darup sehn, dat de senge sick fyn rymen mit den festen, wen se neyne senge darto hebben, so nemen se de frolikesten psalmen edder lede unde sehn jo darup, dat de gesenge uth der reynen scrift syn unde reyn unde lustich unde vorstentlick vor de leyen uth Gades wörde gemaket.

The schoolmasters shall see to it that the songs rhyme finely with the feasts. When they have no songs for them, let them take the most joyful psalms or songs, and see always that the songs be out of the pure Scripture, and pure and pleasant and understandable for the laity, made out of God's word.

The Kurpfalz order of 1556 wants the songs to follow "the teaching and the order of the season", so that the church is reminded of the necessary articles "both with preaching and singing". **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 165):

> Man soll sich auch fleissigen, das sich die gsang nach der leer und zeitordnung richten, als nemlich: auf den Christag und nachvolgenden festen von der geburt Christi, zur Ostern von der urstend Christi, damit die kirch der nötigen stuck der leer des christlichen glaubens, beid, mit predigen und singen, wol erinnert werde.

One shall also be diligent that the songs be ordered after the teaching and the order of the season: namely, on Christmas Day and the feasts following, of the birth of Christ; at Easter, of the resurrection of Christ; that the church may be well reminded of the necessary pieces of the teaching of the Christian faith, both with preaching and singing.

The Sayn *Kirchenzuchtordnung* of 1582 repeats this almost word for word (Sehling 19/1, p. 369). Hanau-Lichtenberg (1573) opens its three rules with the same point (§8.11.5).

The Württemberg court church order of 1560 made the court preachers settle the hymns with the choirmaster, so that the singing followed the season and not "his own nod". **Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 428):

> Es sollen auch allwegen die Hof Prediger sich mit dem Cappell maister vergleichen, was er singen solle, unnd das sich das gesannge de tempore, obgemellter Ordnung nach, schickhe unnd nit, wie bißher beschehen, ad nutum ipsius gesungen werdenn.

The court preachers shall also always agree with the choirmaster what he shall sing, and that the singing fit the season according to the order above, and be not sung at his own nod, as hath hitherto been done.

### 8.18.3 Fitting the gospel and the sermon

The later orders go further. The hymn is to agree with the gospel and "the chief teaching of the sermon". **Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582**, the German school order (Sehling 15, p. 503):

> Er soll sich vermög unser kirchenordnung jedertzeit soviel muglich befleissen, solche psalmen zu singen, die mit den gewöhnlichen evangeliis und der haubtlehr der predigt ubereinstimmen. Er soll sich auch am sontag mit dem organisten zuvor underreden und vergleichen, was er singen wöll, damit es kein confuss und unordnung geb.

He shall, according to our church order, be diligent at all times as much as possible to sing such psalms as agree with the customary gospels and the chief teaching of the sermon. He shall also on the Sunday speak beforehand with the organist and agree what he will sing, that there be no confusion and disorder.

The Hohenlohe *Gesangsordnung* of 1596 gives the reason in its closing paragraph. When the hymns are fitted to the sermons, the common man will feel that the singing is "no superfluous or vain ceremony" but "a short summary and pleasant instruction". It also forbids cutting psalms off in the middle. **Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 657):

> das die pfarrherr mit guettem bedacht, sovil müglich, alle gesang vor und nach auf die predigten richten wöllen, damit der gemein man vermittelst göttlicher gnaden in seinem hertzen empfinde, das das gesang nicht ein übrige oder vergebenliche ceremonia, sonder ein kurtzer begriff und lustige underweißung ist, dardurch uns allerley, so zur seeligkeit zu wissen nottwendig, gantz schön und lieblich zue hertzen gefurt werde.

that the pastors, with good consideration, as much as possible, will direct all songs before and after to the sermons; that the common man, by means of divine grace, may feel in his heart that the singing is not a superfluous or vain ceremony, but a short summary and pleasant instruction, whereby all manner of things necessary to be known for salvation are brought home to our hearts most fairly and lovely.

The Kassel general synod of 1607 (Reformed) asked for the hymn numbers to be posted on a board at the church doors, and for an order of hymns "by the seasons of the year and fitted to the texts that are to be preached". **Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 9, pp. 75–76):

> das die psalmen, so in der versamblung gesungen werden sollen, jederzeitt von dem glöckner oder opfferman, der sich des psalmens bei dem, so die predig halten wirdt, zuevorderst zuerkundigen hette, auff ein tefflein, an den pforden der kirchen oder wie es sich sonsten der kirchen beschaffenheitt nach fuglich thun lassen wolte, mit der zall bezeichnett wurde.

that the psalms which are to be sung in the assembly be at all times marked with their number by the bell-ringer or sexton (who should first inquire of the psalm from him that is to hold the sermon) upon a little board at the doors of the church, or as it might otherwise be fitly done according to the condition of the church.

> das es nicht undienlich wehre, das die psalmen undt andere christliche geseng in eine gewiesse ordnung nach den zeitten des jahrs undt die sich auff die textus, wel[…]che gepredigt werden solten, accommodirt, verfast undt den pfarhern, sonderlich auff dem landt, communicirt wurden.

that it were not unserviceable that the psalms and other Christian songs be drawn up into a certain order according to the seasons of the year, and accommodated to the texts which should be preached, and communicated to the pastors, especially in the country.

#### 8.18.4 That the people may learn them: few, familiar, often repeated

A second group of reasons concerns the congregation's knowledge. The fewer the hymns, the sooner they are learned. The Sponheim order uses the longest hymns before the sermon and the shortest after it. It also prints a short list of hymns to be used "often and before others". **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91** (Sehling 18, p. 657):

> Inn stetten und flecken, do schulen sein, mag man in den kirchen die lieder und psalmen fast gebrauchen, die in der kirchenordnung zu finden, doch mit diesem gemeinen bescheidt, das annfangs und vor der predig die lengste, nach der predig aber die kurzste gesungen werden. Und damit das gemein volck mit vielen gesangen nit beschwert, sondern desto eher mit singen lernen, ist vonnöten, das etlich furnembste psalmen und lieder zum offtermahlen und fur andern, schweren und ihnen uhntauglichen liedern gebraucht werden. Und sollenn demnach volgende lieder offt und fur andern gebraucht werden, doch wo etwan ein gemein albereit etliche mehr lieder, so in der kirchenordnung begrieffen, gelernet hette, sollen dieselbe hiemit uhnverbotten sein.

In towns and market towns where there are schools, the songs and psalms that are found in the church order may for the most part be used in the churches; yet with this common direction, that at the beginning and before the sermon the longest, but after the sermon the shortest be sung. And that the common people be not burdened with many songs, but the sooner learn to sing, it is needful that some chief psalms and songs be used oftener and before others, [rather than] hard songs unfit for them. And accordingly the following songs shall be used often and before others; yet where a congregation hath already learned more songs contained in the church order, these shall hereby not be forbidden.

Danzig wanted the same hymns used "two [Sundays] running", especially those that contained the parts of the catechism. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, as summarised and quoted by Sehling (Sehling 4, p. 168):

> Ein Psalm, 2 oder 3 „nach der zeit gelegenheit, welche die ganze kirche auch lernen und mitsingen sol und darum oft sollen einerlei gesenge etliche zwei nach einander gebraucht werden, namentlich diejenigen, in welchen die stücke des catechismi ordentlich gefasset“.

A psalm, two or three, "according to the occasion of the season, which the whole church also shall learn and sing along; and therefore the same songs shall often be used some two [times] one after another, namely those in which the pieces of the catechism are orderly comprised."

Mecklenburg sang German hymns before and after the weekday sermons "that they may become known and common to the people, and hearts be thereby stirred to prayer". **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 201):

> An solchen tagen sollen vor und nach der predigt deudsche geistliche lieder gesungen werden, damit sie dem volk bekant und gemein werden, und die herzen dadurch zum gebet erwecket werden. Als sonderlich: Vater unser im himelreich, Wo gott der herr nicht bei uns wer, Ein feste burg etc.

On such days German spiritual songs shall be sung before and after the sermon, that they may become known and common to the people, and hearts be thereby stirred up to prayer; as especially "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," "Were God the Lord not with us," "A mighty fortress," etc.

Reutlingen listed the psalm-hymns that had once been "common and known in the church" and wanted all of them brought back. The feast hymns it did not list, "for they are otherwise known well enough". **Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566** (Sehling 17/2, p. 51):

> Dise psalmen seind alle sampt in der kirchen gemain und bekant gewesen, sollen derowegen alle wider darein gebracht werden. Die geseng uf die sonderliche hohe fest haben wir nit hieher verzaichnen wöllen, dan sie sonst gnugsamlich bekant seind.

These psalms have all been common and known in the church; they shall therefore all be brought back into it. The songs for the special high feasts we have not wished to list here, for they are otherwise known well enough.

Hesse (Moderate Reformed) wanted the sung psalms explained in sermons, "for what one understandeth not goeth slowly to the heart". **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 255):

> sonderlich aber gehets ohn frucht nit abe, wenn die psalmen ausgelegt werden, zuvoraus die, so von der ganzen gemein gesungen; denn also verstehen sie alles besser, was in der h. versamlung von der kirchen verricht wird. Es werden auch die gemüter under dem singen desto mehr zur andacht und gottseliger betrachtung entzündet; denn was man nit verstehet, gehet einem langsam zu herzen.

But especially it goeth not off without fruit when the psalms are expounded, above all those that are sung by the whole congregation; for so they understand the better all that is done by the church in the holy assembly. The minds also are the more kindled to devotion and godly meditation under the singing; for what one understandeth not goeth slowly to the heart.

**Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 19/1, p. 369):

> sollen die pastorn das volck ermahnen, das sie die christliche lieder unndt psalmen lehrnen unndt mit gemeinen kirchengesang unsern hern Gott helffen loben unndt preisen, das sie durch die geseng gottlichs worts, so darinnen verfaßet, erinnert unndt daraus ahn rechten erkendnus Gottes, ahn glaube, liebe, gedult unndt ahn allen andern tugenden gebeßert werden. Unndt damit eine guete ordnung unndt gleichheit in den gesengen getroffen werde, sollen die lieder furnemblich, so doctoris Martini Luther[i sind] […].

the pastors shall exhort the people to learn the Christian songs and psalms and to help praise and extol our Lord God with the common singing of the church, that through the songs they may be reminded of God's word that is comprised therein, and thereby be bettered in the right knowledge of God, in faith, love, patience and all other virtues. And that a good order and uniformity may be kept in the songs, the songs chiefly that are Doctor Martin Luther's [shall be used] […].

#### 8.18.5 Luther's hymns first

From the 1560s several orders put Luther's hymns ahead of all others. The Prussian order of 1568 gives the reason: in them "the whole holy catechism" is set out "with rich, fair and mighty exposition". **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

> Es sollen aber nicht allerlei deutsche lieder gesungen werden in der kirche, in dörfern sowohl als in stedten, sondern vornehmlich Lutheri psalmen behalten und getrieben werden, denn darinnen hat man gar schön den ganzen heiligen catechismum mit reicher, schöner und gewaltiger auslegung, erstlich der zehn gebot in zweien gesengen: Dies sind die heiligen zehn gebot etc. und: Mensch, willst du leben seliglich etc.; zum andern, die artikel unsers christlichen glaubens im: Wir glauben all' an einen gott etc., zum dritten das gebet im: Vater unser im himmelreich etc., den ganzen schatz der heiligen taufe im: Christ, unser herr, zum Jordan kam etc., und denn allen nöthigen bericht von dem heiligen abendmahl im: Jesus Christus, unser heiland etc., und: Gott sei gelobet etc. Wer denn das summa summarum sammt dem nutzen und frommen darvon kurz beisammen haben will, der singe: Nu freut euch, lieben christen gemein etc., oder D. Sperati gar schönen psalmen: Es ist das heil uns kommen her etc.

But not all manner of German songs shall be sung in the church, in villages as in towns, but chiefly Luther's psalms shall be kept and used. For in them one hath most fairly the whole holy catechism with rich, fair and mighty exposition: first, of the Ten Commandments in two songs, "These are the holy ten commandments," etc., and "Man, wilt thou live blessedly," etc.; secondly, the articles of our Christian faith in "We all believe in one God," etc.; thirdly, the prayer in "Our Father in the kingdom of heaven," etc.; the whole treasure of holy baptism in "Christ our Lord to Jordan came," etc.; and then all needful instruction of the holy Supper in "Jesus Christ our Saviour," etc., and "God be praised," etc. Whoso then will have the sum of sums, together with the use and profit thereof, briefly together, let him sing "Now rejoice, dear Christians all," etc., or Doctor Speratus's most fair psalm, "Salvation now is come to us," etc.

It then turns on the new hymn-writers (Sehling 4, p. 76):

> Dass also nicht von nöten ist, allerlei neue lieder aufzuraffen und in die kirchen zu bringen, wir haben sie gottlob gut, als sie künden gemacht werden, und mangelt nirgend an, denn dass man des teuren schatzes müde und überdrüssig ist, lust und liebe hat, was neues vorzunehmen, bis man endlich schier gar von den herrlichen psalmen Lutheri kömmet und ein jeder sein eigen gedicht furtreget, welches doch Luthero nicht kan das wasser reichen in genere dictionis oder

> ponderibus rerum. Darum sollen die pfarherren zusehen, den schulmeistern nicht gestatten, ihres gefallens zu singen, sondern daran sein, dass die gesenge droben gehalten und fleissig getrieben werden.

So that it is not needful to snatch up all manner of new songs and bring them into the churches. We have them, God be praised, as good as they can be made, and there is lack nowhere, save that men are weary and tired of the precious treasure and have lust and love to take up something new; until at last they come away almost wholly from the glorious psalms of Luther, and everyone bringeth forward his own poem, which yet cannot hold a candle to Luther in the kind of diction or the weight of matter. Therefore the pastors shall see to it that they suffer not the schoolmasters to sing at their own pleasure, but take care that the songs above be kept and diligently used.

Hoya says the same, and warns that where everyone wants to be a poet, error easily takes root. It also places boys among the people to teach them. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1151):

> Die pastorn sollen mit fleis erhalten die psalmen, so vom Doctore Luthero gemacht und man von anfang des evangelii gehabt und gesungen, und dieselben fleissig treiben und grossen fleis dran wenden, das die leute in der kirchen stets den andern verß singen mögen und der chor so lang schweigen. Zu solcher beförderung kan man ein bar knaben unter dem volk stehen oder sitzen lassen, die da singen und sich die leute bey denselben also zum singen gewehnen. Man mag auch wol andere christliche gesenge, sofern sie rein und Gottes wort gemeß sein, gebrauchen, doch der neuerung nicht zuviel machen noch die alten geseng verwerfen. Dann es befindet sich, wo jederman tichter sein und seine eigene geseng machen und gebrauchen wil, das leichtlich irrung mit einwurzeln mögen.

The pastors shall diligently keep the psalms that were made by Doctor Luther and that have been had and sung from the beginning of the gospel, and use them diligently, and bestow great diligence that the people in the church may always sing the second verse and the choir meanwhile keep silence. For the furtherance of this a pair of boys may be made to stand or sit among the people, who sing, so that the people accustom themselves to singing along with them. Other Christian songs also may well be used, so far as they be pure and agreeable to God's word; yet let not too much novelty be made, nor the old songs rejected. For it is found that where every man will be a poet and make and use his own songs, error may easily take root therewith.

**Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 738):

> Der zwölfte articul. Sectio prima. Von den gesängen, so man in der kirchen gebrauchen soll. Ordnen wir, daß die psalmen, so von Doct. Luthero, sel. gedechtniß, gemacht und in den psalmboeken gefunden werden, vor andern am meisten sollen gesungen und gebrauchet werden. Jedoch wollen wir hiemit an die löbliche gesenge, latein oder teutsch, auf den hohen festtagen bestimpt und in dem göttlichen worte fundiret, nit verworfen haben.

The twelfth article, first section: of the songs which shall be used in the church. We ordain that the psalms which were made by Doctor Luther of blessed memory and are found in the psalm books shall be sung and used most of all, before others. Yet hereby we will not have rejected the praiseworthy songs, Latin or German, appointed for the high feast days and grounded in the divine word.

The same order forbids schoolmasters and sextons to sing hymns "at their pleasure" without the pastor's knowledge. It forbids songs the people are not used to, and songs "that have the same tune as worldly songs", at which the common man might take offence (Sehling 7/1, p. 739):

> auch den scholemeistern und kostern befehlen, daß sie ohne furwißen der pastorn ihres gefallenß die psalme nit singen, dazue noch das kaspelsvolk nit gewehnet, noch sonsten die, so weltlicher lieder gleiche weiße haben, doran sich der gemeine man ergern möchte.

also command the schoolmasters and sextons that they sing not the psalms at their pleasure without the foreknowledge of the pastors, [nor such] as the parish folk are not yet used to, nor otherwise those that have the same tune as worldly songs, whereat the common man might be offended.

Mansfeld built its seasonal hymn plan from Luther's songbook. It marked with an asterisk the hymns in that book by "other excellent men". It did not bind other territories to its order. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 235):

> haben demnach d. Luthers deutsches gesang büchlein für uns genomen, und dieselben gesenge so darinnen verfasset sein, auf die festa und gemeinen sontage und sonst auf andere tage abgetheilet, wie wir vermeinen nach unserem

> einfalde, das sie zu den predigten am bequemesten und den leuten aufs beste einzubilden sein solten. Weil aber in dem gesang büchlein Lutheri, auch anderer fürtrefflicher leute gute und geistreiche gesenge mit einverleibet seind, haben wir dieselben nicht aussen lassen wollen, sondern an gelegene orter mit hinzu gesetzet, und zum unterscheid von doct. Luthers gesengen mit diesem zeichen * notiren wollen.

We have therefore taken Doctor Luther's German songbook before us, and divided the songs contained therein among the feasts and common Sundays and otherwise other days, as we suppose in our simplicity that they should be most fitting to the sermons and best to be impressed upon the people. But because in Luther's songbook good and spiritual songs of other excellent men also are incorporated, we would not leave them out, but have set them in at fitting places, and to distinguish them from Doctor Luther's songs we have marked them with this sign: *.

The same Mansfeld article explains why hymns had spread so fast: "as all men are by nature inclined to sing and have pleasure in music" (Sehling 2, p. 235):

> Wie nu alle menschen natürlich zu singen geneiget sein und zur musica lust haben, also haben sie solche gesenge mit grosser begirde angenomen und aus denselben den grund der warheit fest und stark gefasset.

As now all men are naturally inclined to sing and have pleasure in music, so have they received such songs with great desire, and out of them grasped the ground of the truth firmly and strongly.

At Langenburg in Hohenlohe the question became a dispute in 1592. The pastor there, Mögner, objected that singing only Luther's hymns would mean giving up long-used songs by Spengler, Speratus, Kreuziger, Jonas and others. He appealed to the last paragraph of the 1578 order, to sing "at all times what is serviceable and answerable to the matter" (Sehling 15, p. 625):

> so wöllen wir, laut des letzten paragraphi hei den gsengen j ederzeit singen, was zur sach dienstlich und verantwortlich.

so will we, according to the last paragraph on the songs, sing at all times what is serviceable and answerable to the matter.

#### 8.18.6 Against private choice and novelty; the authorized books

Hof defended its whole plan against any "unskilled scholar" who might change it at his pleasure. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 455):

> sintemal nicht einem iden unverstendigen schuler geburen will, in unser schönen und wolbedachten kirchenordnung seines gefallens umbzusturen und, was ime in seinem namen gutdeucht, in der gemein Gottes zu singen, sintemal die alten auch leut gewesen und freilich ohn großen vorbedacht nichts furgenommen haben.

since it will not become every unskilled scholar to overturn at his pleasure our fair and well-considered church order, and to sing in the congregation of God what seemeth good to him in his own name; since the old ones were also men, and surely undertook nothing without great forethought.

Pfalz-Zweibrücken closed its songbook with a ban on novelty, "that constant uniformity be kept, as well in singing as in preaching". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557**, songbook (Sehling 18, p. 255):

> Diser obgesetzten Kirchengeseng sollen sich die Pfarrherr und Kirchendiener gebrauchen und ferner kein newerung einfüren, damit so wol im Gesang alß in der Predig und teglichen lehre Christliche, bestendige gleychheyt gehalten werde.

These church songs set above the pastors and ministers shall use, and bring in no further novelty, that Christian, constant uniformity be kept as well in singing as in preaching and daily teaching.

Grubenhagen tied the whole service to Johann Spangenberg's cantional. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1048):

> sollen dieselben mit gebürlicher modestien und bescheidenheit ordentlich und gleichstimmig gehalten und nichts neues von jemands erdacht oder fürgenommen werden. Wann denn lange zeit hero das cantional oder missal des alten herrn Johan Spangenberges in unserm fürstenthumb ublich gewesen und dasselbe jeder kirchen in verwahrung und brauch beygelegt worden, sol ein jeder auf die Sontag, fest und aposteltage in haltung des kirchenampts mit lectionen, singen,

> collecten, introiten, Kyrie, Patrem, praefationen, hymnis, und was dergleichen mehr ist, nach ordnung der zeit sich vleissig richten.

the same shall be held with due modesty and discretion, orderly and with one voice, and nothing new be devised or undertaken by anyone. Since, then, the cantional or missal of the old master Johann Spangenberg hath long been customary in our principality, and the same hath been given to every church for keeping and use, every one shall diligently order himself by it on the Sundays, feasts and apostles' days in holding the office, with lessons, singing, collects, introits, Kyrie, *Patrem*, prefaces, hymns and whatever more there is of the like, according to the order of the season.

Oldenburg required "a right, pure cantional", Spangenberg's or Lossius's, with Luther's German songbook. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085):

> Zu der behülf ist vonnöten, das in allen kirchen und schulen ein rechtes, reines cantional stetigs zur hand sey, als nemlich des alten herrn Johan. Spangebergii oder Lucae Lossii sampt dem deudschen gesangbuch D. Martini Lutheri.

For the furtherance of which it is needful that in all churches and schools a right, pure cantional be always at hand, as namely that of the old master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German songbook of Doctor Martin Luther.

It adds that the Luther songbook must be one "printed at no suspect place and unfalsified". This was aimed at the Reformed-leaning printings of the 1560s and 1570s (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1087):

> und mag vor der prediger [!] ein deudschen psalm aus Lutheri gesangbuch, das an keinen verdechtigem ort gedruckt und unvorfelschet ist gesungen werden.

and before the sermon a German psalm may be sung out of Luther's songbook, [one] that is printed at no suspect place and is unfalsified.

Rostock required Lossius in every church, and one melody everywhere. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, pp. 288–289):

> Es wird für gut angesehen und notig eracht, das man in allen kirchen halten sol Lucae Lossii psalmodia und sol sich das chor darnach richten.

It is thought good and needful that Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept in all churches, and the choir order itself thereby.

> Es sollen sich auch die schulmeister und cantores bevleissigen, das in allen gesengen musste einerlei melodia gehalten werden.

The schoolmasters and cantors also shall be diligent that in all songs one melody be kept.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* ordered every church to buy Lossius's cantional (§8.8.6).

#### 8.18.7 Latin and German

The orders agree that the congregation sings in German. They differ on how much Latin to keep, and why. Bugenhagen defended the Latin chants for the sake of the Latin school children. He reproved those who would have "all things and singing in German, as though it were wrong to sing a Latin word". **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 438):

> Wy laven overs nicht, ock schelden nicht, sonder seggen, dat de id eyn weynich to nowe nemen, de alle dink unde sank so willen düdesch hebben, gelick efft id unrecht were, eyn latinisch wort edder eyn ander to syngen. Dewile doch Paulus recht, me schal mit tungen reden nicht vorbeden. Wen de leyen de düdesche misse hebben, so scholen se den latinischen kynderen unde andern to gude holden, dat se to tiden singen eyn latinisch Gloria in excelsis, eyn Haleluja, Sanctus, Agnus unde sundergen sank, alse sequentien in den dren groten festen, doch düdesch dar mank edder darneven gesungen.

We praise not, nor do we chide, but say that they take it a little too strictly who will have all things and singing in German, as though it were wrong to sing a Latin word or another; since Paul saith rightly that one shall not forbid to speak with tongues. When the laity have the German Mass, they shall bear with the Latin children and others, that these sing at times a Latin *Gloria*

*in excelsis*, an alleluia, Sanctus, Agnus, and special songs, as sequences on the three great feasts; yet with German sung in among them or beside them.

East Frisia kept the Latin "because we will that the Latin tongue, together with all good arts, as music, be kept in honour". **Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 7/1, p. 380):

> Wente wy willen, dat de latinische sprake sampt alle gude kunsten, alze de musica, in den kercken und scholen in eheren geholden werden.

For we will that the Latin tongue, together with all good arts, as music, be held in honour in the churches and schools.

Hohenlohe kept the Latin for the schools and added German "for the unlearned and those inexperienced in the Latin tongue". **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 60):

> umb derselbigen willen die lateinische gesang im prauch behalten und darneben auch die teutsche gesang vonwegen der ungelerten und d[er lateynischen sprach unerfahren].

for its sake keep the Latin songs in use, and beside them also the German songs, because of the unlearned and those inexperienced in the Latin tongue.

Hesse (1574, Philippist) reasoned from 1 Corinthians 14: whoever does not understand cannot say Amen. It allowed Latin only before the congregation had gathered, and at vespers when few were there. It also limited the singing before the sermon to half an hour on feast days and a quarter of an hour on weekdays. **Hessen, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 411):

> Wie kann aber einer Amen sagen, zu dem, das er nicht verstehet und nit weiß, was damit gemeint ist? 1. Cor. 14. Derhalben, gleich wie alle predigten, gebet und danksagung in bekanter teutscher sprach geschehen, also soll auch der gesang, wann der ganze gemeine hauf beieinander ist, teutsch sein. Dieweil aber doch in stedten, da mancherlei leut seind, viel erfunden werden, so in schulen erzogen und das latein verstehen, dergleichen oftmals frembde leut, welchen diese sprach wol bekant, zu den gemeinen versamblungen sich verfügen, mag underweilen im anfang, ehe die ganze gemein zusammenkompt, und zur vesper, wann ohn das wenig leut vorhanden, ein lateinischer psalm oder introitus gesungen werden, doch daß auf den dorfen durchaus, in stedten aber mehrerteils allein teutsche gesenge im gemeinen brauch seien und bleiben. Es söllen auch die gesenge aufs kürzest angestellet und vor der predigt auf die feiertage über eine halbe, auf die werktage aber über ein vierteil stunde aufs höchste nicht erstreckt werden, damit das volk nicht aufgehalten und, ehe dann die predigt angehet, zum überdruß verursacht werden möge.

But how can one say Amen to that which he understandeth not and knoweth not what is meant thereby? 1 Corinthians 14. Therefore, as all sermons, prayer and thanksgiving are done in the known German tongue, so also the singing, when the whole common multitude is together, shall be German. But since in towns, where there are many kinds of people, many are found who were brought up in schools and understand Latin, and likewise strangers often come to the common assemblies to whom this tongue is well known, a Latin psalm or introit may be sung at times at the beginning, before the whole congregation cometh together, and at vespers, when few people are present anyway; yet so that in the villages wholly, and in the towns for the most part, only German songs be and remain in common use. The songs also shall be set as short as may be, and before the sermon shall not be stretched on feast days over half an hour, and on working days over a quarter of an hour at the most, that the people be not held up, and be caused to weariness before the sermon beginneth.

Sayn called Latin singing in the papacy "a special punishment of God", citing Isaiah 28 and 1 Corinthians 14 (Sehling 19/1, p. 369):

> das es bißher beschehen im bapstumb, vor ein sonderlich straff Gottes zu achten, wie Esaias 28 unndt S. Paulus 1. Corinth. 14 bezeugen. Unndt hatt das ansehen, das solch kirchen gesangh, so in unbekanter sprach beschehen, soll seines […] wercks verdienst halben Gottes zorn versohnen.

that it hath hitherto happened in the papacy is to be counted a special punishment of God, as Isaiah 28 and St Paul, 1 Corinthians 14, bear witness. And it hath the appearance that such church singing, done in an unknown tongue, was supposed by the merit of its work to reconcile God's wrath.

#### 8.18.8 Length

Long singing was to be avoided "that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not become tedious". **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 341):

> Lange singent dar etlike prestere lust to hebben, schal ut orsake vormeeden werden, dat sulke christlike unde heelsamen ceremonien dem volke lüstich bliven, unde nicht vordreetlick werden.

Long singing, wherein some priests have pleasure, shall for this cause be avoided: that such Christian and wholesome ceremonies may remain pleasant to the people and not become tedious.

Two, or at most three, pieces of figured music at one service are enough, "that the people also may have room to praise God with song". **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 54):

> Twe gude stücke edder thom högesten dre in figurativis sind up eine tidt genoch, dat dat volk ock rhum hebbe, Got mit sange tho lavende, besundergen under der communion, alse Christus secht: Sülck doht tho myner gedechtnisse.

Two good pieces, or at the most three, in figured music are enough at one time, that the people also may have room to praise God with song, especially during the communion, as Christ saith: "This do in remembrance of me."

Schönburg held weekday singing and preaching together to one hour, "so the people are kept willing to go to the sermon and can also come home to work". **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 171):

> Summa, dass allezeit in der wochen, an werktagen alles singen und predigen in einer stunde geschehen und nicht darüber. Se behält man das volk willig zur predigt gehen und kan auch anheimb kommen zur arbeit.

In sum, that always in the week, on working days, all singing and preaching be done in one hour and not beyond. So the people are kept willing to go to the sermon, and can also come home to work.

#### 8.18.9 The organ

The organ was allowed, "neither commanded nor forbidden". It was not a way of serving God, but like a trumpet that moves people to pray, hear the word, and come to church. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 461):

> Orgelen unde Musica, de fry syn, noch gebaden noch vorbaden, mach me gebruken, nicht darumme, Godt darmede tho denende unde Affgöderye tho stercken unde den rechten Gades denst tho weren, alse de Papisten don, sunder alse eine trammete edder süs ein geschrey, dar de minschen mede beweget werden unde orsake averkamen, unde tho bidden unde flitich Gades wort tho hören, gelick alse Helizeus an der Harpen wyssagede, unde yn de Kercken tho ghande unde tho blivende.

Organs and music, which are free, neither commanded nor forbidden, may be used; not in order to serve God therewith and to strengthen idolatry and hinder the right service of God, as the Papists do; but as a trumpet or else a cry, whereby men are moved and get occasion both to pray and diligently to hear God's word, even as Elisha prophesied at the harp, and to go into the church and abide there.

Heilbronn grounded the organ in the Psalms and in the pleasure of melody, which stirs the heart. **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 317):

> unnd dieweil gott in allen dingen in Orgeln, Cimbalen unnd Saitenspielen globt werden soll, wie in den hailligen psalmen geschriben ist, und auch der menschen hertz nicht allein durch solche liebliche melodey erfreyt und erwechkt, die gottlichen gutthaten zu berichten.

and since God is to be praised in all things, in organs, cymbals and stringed instruments, as is written in the holy psalms, and the heart of men also is not only gladdened and awakened by such lovely melody to tell of the divine benefits [...].

The organist was to play only after the choir or church had begun, and to agree with the schoolmaster beforehand. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 78):

> schall der organiste in der misse, metten und vesper spelen, dat de chorr edder de ganze kercke vorher anhevet und singet. Der schulmeister schall sick stedes vorher mit dem organisten des sanges halven vorgliken, alle unschicklicheit und confusion to vorhodende.

the organist shall play at Mass, matins and vespers that which the choir or the whole church first beginneth and singeth. The schoolmaster shall always agree beforehand with the organist touching the singing, to prevent all unseemliness and confusion.

Harlingerland forbade organists to play worldly songs. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 739):

> Und nachdeme an örtern, daselbst örgeln sind, die organisten unfieisig werden befunden und weltliche lieder schlagen, dorauß ergerniß erfolgen, aber gleichwoll in der heiligen schrift dieselben nit verbotten, sondern damit den allmechtigen zu loben und preisen, ordnen wir, daß die organisten mit ernste ihreß dienstes wahrnehmen und herrliche geistliche stucke, der hilligen schrift einhell[ig, schlagen].

And since in places where there are organs the organists are found unfaithful and play worldly songs, whereof offence followeth, although these [organs] are not forbidden in holy Scripture, but [given] to praise and extol the Almighty therewith, we ordain that the organists attend to their service earnestly and [play] glorious spiritual pieces, agreeing with holy Scripture.

In polyphonic settings for the court chapel of Württemberg the familiar tune was to be kept in the tenor or another voice, so the people could recognize it. **Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 427):

> Zum beschluß soll man alwegen ein teutschen Psalmen singen unnd sich in Compositionibus befleissenn, daß die gewonlichen, gepreuchige Melodi uff den Tenor oder ein anndere Stim gerichtet werde.

At the close a German psalm shall always be sung, and in the compositions care shall be taken that the customary, familiar melody be set in the tenor or another voice.

The organ's silence in certain seasons and the limits on what the organist might play are treated in Chapter 9, §§9.3.6–9.3.7.

#### 8.18.10 Freedom

Many orders end their rules on singing with a clause of freedom, or leave the choice to the pastor, and some say plainly that such ceremonies are not laws. Northeim: "such things must be free and subject to no law" (§8.8.1). Goslar (1528) left the burial singing to "a godly, reasonable, learned pastor" (§8.17.4). Mansfeld did not bind others to its plan (§8.18.5). Nördlingen's St George's order (1555), after Naumburg, lets the Gloria be dropped when the hymns after the epistle are long, "for such ceremonies shall at all times be free for the pastor to change according to the people's convenience". **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555** (Sehling 12, p. 322):

> Man mag auch wol das Gioria in excelsis außen lassen, wenn die geseng nach [der] epistel etwas lang sind; denn solche ceremonien sollen one das dem pfarher nach des volks bequemhait zu endern alle zeit frei stehen.

One may also well leave out the *Gloria in excelsis* when the songs after the epistle are somewhat long; for such ceremonies shall at all times be free for the pastor to change according to the people's convenience.

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## 8.19 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **Hymn practice**: a short note on what the order contributes.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

**Luther; Saxony and Thuringia; the Harz counties, Magdeburg, Halberstadt and Anhalt**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, pp. 6, 8–9 | 2 | wish for vernacular songs near gradual, Sanctus, Agnus; "Gott sei gelobet" after communion; *Benedicamus* in place of *Ite missa* | 8.3.2, 8.15.2, 8.16.8 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1, pp. 14–15 | 3 | German psalm at opening; hymn after epistle; "Wir glauben all"; Sanctus, "Gott sei gelobet", Hus hymn at communion | 8.3.2 |
| Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 | 1, pp. 169–170 | 9 | songs to differ at feasts; "Mitten wir im Leben" at burial | 8.17.4, 8.18.2 |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 | 1, pp. 271–275 | 30 | sequence or German psalm "as the season requireth"; village hymn "pro introitu"; "Christe du Lamm" to close; wedding psalms | 8.5.1, 8.8.1, 8.15.1, 8.15.2, 8.17.2 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545 | 1, p. 300 | 33 | Latin chant with kneeling prayer "an stadt des offertorii" | 8.11.3 |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1580 | 1, p. 369 | 44 | communion hymns "one or more" by number of communicants | 8.14.2 |
| Allstedt, Thomas Müntzer, *Deutsch kirchenampt*, [1523] (Radical Reformation) | 1, pp. 475–491 | 50 | German *Benedicamus*, with alleluia at Easter | 8.16.8 |
| Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574 | 1, p. 555 | 78 | all communion hymns sung when communicants are many | 8.14.2 |
| Eisfeld, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1554 | 1, p. 562 | 84 | Hus's hymn at communion | 8.14.1 |
| Pirna, *Kirchenordnung* of Anton Lauterbach, 1555 | 1, pp. 642–643 | 119 | two German hymns per Sunday, by the sense of epistle and gospel | 8.8.7 |
| Weissenfels, *Ordnung der geseng*, 1578 | 1, pp. 693–694 | 145 | one hymn per Sunday "that fitteth season and gospel" (table in `hymns.db`) | 8.8.6 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 1, pp. 704–705 | 148 | German Benedictus first; farced sequences; communion hymns "until the communion is over"; German Te Deum | 8.4.3, 8.6.1, 8.8.2, 8.14.2, 8.16.4 |
| Merseburg, *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545 | 2, p. 7 | 1210 | *Veni creator* at ordination | 8.17.5 |
| Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1527 | 2, p. 60 | 1218 | "Nun bitten" with added stanza; "Aus tiefer Not" for the offertory | 8.10.1, 8.11.3 |
| Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538 | 2, pp. 71–78 | 1219 | three introit-hymns in rotation; troped German Kyries; "All Ehr und Lob"; hymns split around sermon; *Puer natus in Bethlehem* upon the Magnificat at Christmas | 8.5.2, 8.6.4, 8.7.4, 8.8.6, 8.11.6, 8.16.10 |
| Bischofswerda, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, printed from a letter of 1676 | 2, p. 106 | 1226 | festal songs "zum introitu" (*Puer natus in Bethlehem*) | 8.16.10 |
| Plauen, *Ordnung der Ceremonien*, 1529 | 2, p. 111 | 1227 | *Salve Jesu Christe* | 8.16.5 |
| Schwarzburg and Stolberg, *Ordenunge der religion*, 1549 | 2, p. 130 | 1230 | people sing the Lord's Prayer hymn | 8.13.1 |
| Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 2, pp. 133, 136 | 1230 | *Leisen* from the pulpit; burial hymn | 8.10.2, 8.17.4 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552 | 2, pp. 153–154 | 1234 | song for peace after every sermon | 8.11.1 |
| Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 2, p. 171 | 1235 | "Erhalt uns" in need; no organ at communion; one-hour weekday rule | 8.11.1, 8.14.7, 8.18.8 |
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580 | 2, pp. 234–238 | 1241 | complaint that Luther's hymns are forgotten; seasonal plan with * for non-Luther hymns; baptism hymns | 8.4.2, 8.8.7, 8.17.1, 8.18.5 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 | 2, pp. 309–311 | 1247 | prose "Komm, heiliger Geist" to the Latin tune; communion hymns by number; seasonal afternoon hymn | 8.4.1, 8.14.2, 8.16.2 |
| Belrieth and Einhausen (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, p. 330 | 1248 | psalm while people gather | 8.4.2 |
| Goldlauter (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, p. 333 | 1248 | wedding hymns; sixth commandment | 8.17.2 |
| Herpf (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, pp. 334–335 | 1248 | German *Kyrie summum*; Hus's "instructive and comforting" hymn | 8.6.4, 8.14.1 |
| Meiningen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnungen*, 1562/1566 | 2, p. 340 | 1248 | Gloria left out in winter | 8.7.5 |
| Obermassfeld (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, p. 343 | 1249 | troped Kyrie "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit" | 8.6.4 |
| Queienfeld (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, pp. 344–345 | 1249 | Hus hymn split around the consecration; catechism hymn held through each part | 8.13.2, 8.16.6 |
| Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562 | 2, p. 351 | 1250 | "Christe du Lamm" to close the communion | 8.15.1 |
| Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf, 1566 | 2, pp. 352–353 | 1250 | German Benedictus for introit; festal hymns for introit | 8.4.3, 8.5.4 |
| Wasungen (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, p. 356 | 1250 | three short German Kyries; "Verleih uns Frieden" at the end | 8.6.4, 8.15.5 |
| Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1543 | 2, p. 436 | 1257 | introit-psalms chosen so the people learn them | 8.5.6 |
| Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575 | 2, p. 478 | 1260 | credal slot rotated over four Sundays | 8.9.1 |
| Cochstedt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556 | 2, p. 484 | 1260 | baptism hymn | 8.17.1 |
| Anhalt, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1548 | 2, p. 554 | 1262 | psalm while communicants go into the choir | 8.11.4 |
| Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 1551 | 2, pp. 555–556 | 1262 | German hymns "woven into" sequences; seasonal hymns for three slots; Trinity hymns kept four Sundays | 8.8.3, 8.8.7, 8.11.6 |
| Harzgerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534 (?) | 2, p. 586 | 1263 | Latin and German Gloria by turns; farced sequences | 8.7.2, 8.8.3 |

**Franconia, Nürnberg, Nördlingen, the Upper Palatinate and Regensburg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nürnberg, Döber's German Mass in the New Hospital, 1525 | 11, p. 56 | 250 | "Nun bitten" printed as the introit | 8.5.3 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533, later appendix | 11, p. 202 | 270 | penitential hymns only for the unrepentant dead | 8.17.4 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533 | 11, p. 316 | 276 | *O crux ave* cut | 8.16.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order) | 11, pp. 329–330 | 278 | pure sequences; psalm-hymns for impure graduals "for the people's sake"; German *Benedicamus* at the end of Mass | 8.5.2, 8.8.2, 8.16.8 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 411–475 | 294 | full Sunday table by slot; kneeling "Nun bitten"; communion hymns by number; baptism, wedding and burial hymns; plan defended against changes; *Benedicamus* graded and in German; motets in its place; *Puer natus in Bethlehem* at the entrance to vespers | 8.3.1, 8.4.1, 8.6.4, 8.8.4, 8.8.8, 8.10.1, 8.12.4, 8.14.2, 8.16.1, 8.16.2, 8.16.7, 8.16.8, 8.16.9, 8.16.10, 8.17.1, 8.17.2, 8.17.4, 8.18.6 |
| Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545 | 11, p. 502 | 297 | "Als Jesus Christus" at communion | 8.14.6 |
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 11, p. 641 | 304 | "Erhalt uns" after the sermon | 8.11.1 |
| Schweinfurt, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1576 | 11, p. 646 | 304 | four-week plan; "Wir glauben" for "Nun bitten" in Advent | 8.9.4 |
| Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 11, p. 659 | 308 | hymns covering the preacher's going up and coming down | 8.10.5, 8.11.2 |
| Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1555 | 11, p. 716 | 323 | Ten Commandments hymn; "Nun freut euch" as a paraphrase of the creed | 8.16.6 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung* of Kaspar Löner, 1544 | 12, pp. 311–312 | 372 | "Komm heiliger Geist" / "Nun bitten" graded by feast; "All Ehr und Lob"; hymn while the elements are prepared | 8.4.1, 8.7.4, 8.10.1, 8.11.4 |
| Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien* at St George's, 1555 | 12, pp. 318–323 | 373 | Gloria left out in Advent; post-epistle list; Sanctus while people gather; freedom clause; "Dank sagen wir alle" for the *Benedicamus* at Christmas | 8.7.5, 8.8.7, 8.12.1, 8.16.9, 8.16.10, 8.18.10 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579 | 12, pp. 375–388 | 375 | introit dropped for long psalms and cold; baptism of Christ hymn; thanksgiving day | 8.5.6, 8.8.7, 8.17.6 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, p. 72 | 386 | people sing "Wir glauben" while priest sings the *Credo* | 8.9.1 |
| Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542 | 13, p. 393 | 432 | Latin Agnus three times; Latin thanksgiving if needed | 8.14.2 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Hieronymus Noppus, 1543 | 13, pp. 408–410 | 436 | weekday psalm "that the people may learn"; hymns for the dying | 8.16.7, 8.17.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553 | 13, pp. 419–426 | 440 | Prussian litany and "Erhalt uns" after the epistle; office hymn "if not godless"; "Nun bitten" at an execution | 8.8.9, 8.16.1, 8.17.6 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 | 13, pp. 461–462 | 450 | "Erhalt uns" as "sequence of the season"; penitential psalm after the *Benedicamus* | 8.8.9, 8.16.9 |
| Ortenburg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1563 | 13, p. 532 | 457 | the Passion at communion | 8.14.6 |
| Rothenberg, *Vereinigung*, 1618 | 13, p. 550 | 461 | "Gott sei gelobet" as thanksgiving | 8.15.2 |

**The Palatinate, Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546 | 14, pp. 96–97 | 472 | pure sequence or tract; *Discubuit* and German *Pange lingua* | 8.8.1, 8.14.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 (with 1577 variants) | 14, pp. 149, 165 | 480 | songs by teaching and season; minister may stop the singing | 8.12.1, 8.14.3, 8.18.2 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15, pp. 60, 74 | 539 | Latin kept beside German; *Salve Regina* abolished | 8.16.5, 8.18.7 |
| Öhringen, *Kirchen- und Schulordnungen*, 1582 | 15, p. 503 | 592 | hymns to agree with gospel and sermon; last stanza after sermon | 8.11.6, 8.18.3 |
| Neuenstein, *Befehle wegen des Gebetsgottesdienstes*, 1588–1594 | 15, p. 540 | 604 | seven psalm-hymns rotated daily | 8.16.7 |
| Langenburg, *Befehl an den Pfarrer*, 1592 | 15, p. 625 | 624 | dispute over singing only Luther's hymns | 8.18.5 |
| Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung*, 1596 | 15, pp. 653–657 | 628 | hymns before and after the sermon by twelve doctrinal articles; catechism, wedding, burial and communion hymns; rationale | 8.10.4, 8.11.5, 8.16.6, 8.17.2, 8.17.4, 8.18.3 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16, pp. 107, 109 | 651 | creed or psalm while pastor goes to altar; hymns examined by superintendents | 8.9.3, 8.18.1 |
| Württemberg, *Synodalordnung*, 1547 | 16, p. 159 | 660 | installation hymns | 8.17.5 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16, p. 252 | 671 | opening hymn before the sermon | 8.3.4 |
| Württemberg, *Hofkirchenordnung*, 1560 | 16, pp. 427–428 | 686 | choirmaster to follow the season; familiar tune in the tenor | 8.18.2, 8.18.9 |
| Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610 | 16, pp. 620, 623 | 729 | communion hymn by season; burial hymn split | 8.14.6, 8.17.4 |
| Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560 | 16, p. 672 | 742 | *Salve Regina coeli* "turned upon Christ" | 8.16.5 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527 | 17/1, pp. 49, 51 | 755 | people to learn the German Gloria; Latin and German by turns at communion | 8.7.3, 8.14.7 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615 | 17/1, p. 174 | 763 | burial hymn split around sermon | 8.17.4 |
| Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 | 17/1, pp. 285–286 | 770 | *Pange lingua* Latin and German at communion | 8.14.5 |
| Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532 | 17/1, pp. 301–302 | 778 | hymn while preacher goes up; German song for the *Salve* | 8.10.5, 8.16.5 |
| Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, p. 317 | 781 | organ grounded in the Psalms | 8.18.9 |
| Heilbronn, *Ordnung des Kirchengesangs*, 1543 | 17/1, pp. 321–323 | 782 | seasonal office hymns; stanza cut; Te Deum at great communions | 8.14.5, 8.16.1, 8.16.2 |
| Reutlingen, *Ordnung der Schule und des Kirchengesangs*, 1565/1566 | 17/2, pp. 49, 51 | 828 | opening hymn until the preacher is up; "not always the old common fiddle"; list of psalm-hymns | 8.4.1, 8.11.5, 8.18.4 |
| Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574 | 17/2, p. 58 | 830 | hymn after sermon to fit the text; no repetition | 8.11.5 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557, songbook | 18, pp. 248, 255 | 968 | three German Kyrie-Gloria pairs; no novelty | 8.6.4, 8.18.6 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Ordnung der Kirchengesänge*, 1565 | 18, pp. 337, 340 | 985 | three-week plan with slot labels; "Nun bitten" every Sunday (table in `hymns.db`); Christmas songs after catechism and sermon | 8.3.1, 8.10.1, 8.16.10 |
| Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91 | 18, p. 657 | 1021 | longest hymns before sermon, shortest after; short canon | 8.18.4 |

**Hesse, Nassau, the Middle Rhine, Westphalia, Strasbourg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 248, 255 | 2257 | psalms while people gather; Ps 51 for the confession; preach on the sung psalms | 8.4.2, 8.4.5, 8.18.4 |
| Hessen, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8, pp. 411–412, 455 | 2272 | "Komm heiliger Geist" kneeling, with rationale; creed options; *Leisen*; hymn while pastor comes down; language and length rules | 8.4.1, 8.9.1, 8.10.2, 8.11.2, 8.17.5, 8.18.7 |
| Hessen-Kassel, *Abschied der Kasseler Generalsynode*, 1607 (Reformed) | 9, pp. 75–76 | 2287 | Lobwasser psalms; hymn boards; call for a seasonal and sermon table | 8.14.6, 8.18.3 |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9, p. 273 | 2300 | Lord's Prayer hymn, Ten Commandments and creed before the sermon | 8.10.3 |
| Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenordnung* [1576–1580] | 9, pp. 359–360 | 2311 | seasonal table before the sermon | 8.10.3 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 | 10, pp. 620, 628, 632 | 228 | *Leisen* or Lord's Prayer before the sermon; baptism and wedding hymns | 8.10.3, 8.17.1, 8.17.2 |
| Worms, *Agendbüchlein*, 1560 | 19/1, pp. 206, 208 | 1069 | "Nun bitten" or *Leise* before the sermon; no new hymn without superintendent | 8.10.2, 8.18.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 | 19/1, p. 267 | 1074 | German hymns at burial instead of the old "singing over" | 8.17.4 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582 | 19/1, p. 369 | 1090 | Latin singing as God's punishment; people to learn the hymns | 8.18.4, 8.18.7 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1, p. 407 | 1090 | church sings the Lord's Prayer | 8.13.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Ordnung des Herren Nachtmal*, 1525 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 156 | 1279 | Ps 51 or Ps 130 "an stat des Introits" | 8.5.3 |
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577 | 20/1, pp. 516, 518 | 1336 | Ps 51 at great communions; no singing, no funeral sermon | 8.14.6, 8.17.4 |
| Hanau-Lichtenberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 20/2, p. 54 | 1364 | three rules: season, few hymns, hymn matched to sermon | 8.11.5 |
| Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 21, pp. 176–177 | 1442 | sequences cut and farced; Our Father or "Nun bitten" before sermon | 8.8.2, 8.10.1 |
| Dortmund, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1554 | 21, pp. 208–209 | 1446 | introit defined as the gathering song; hymn for the offertory | 8.4.2, 8.11.3 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung* of Antonius Corvinus [1542] | 21, p. 345 | 1460 | Ps 67 or "Dank sagen" while bread and wine are prepared | 8.11.3 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 386–396, 438 | 1462 | village Kyrie while people gather; seasonal slot before sermon; catechism hymns; communion hymns | 8.4.2, 8.10.3, 8.14.2, 8.16.6, 8.17.5 |
| Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 | 22, pp. 102–103 | 1493 | festal hymns for introits; German Gloria answer; psalm-hymns rotated | 8.5.4, 8.7.4, 8.8.8, 8.12.1 |
| Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung* [1565] | 22, p. 116 | 1493 | "Aus tiefer Not" as a confession | 8.4.5 |
| Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 22, pp. 243–244 | 1505 | German psalm for the introit; thanksgiving hymns to close | 8.5.1, 8.15.3 |
| Soest, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 22, p. 450 | 1527 | three kneeling boys sing *Veni sancte*; psalm while communicants kneel | 8.4.1, 8.11.4 |
| Neuenrade, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 22, pp. 519, 530–531, 540 | 1544 | seasonal post-epistle table; German Agnus; long *Benedicamus* melodies rejected | 8.8.7, 8.15.1, 8.16.8 |
| Lippe, *Deutsche Messe* [c. 1525–1538] | 22, pp. 565–568 | 1549 | "Aus tiefer Not" as introit; early Low German "Allein Gott"; hymn for the offertory | 8.5.3, 8.7.3, 8.11.3 |

**Lower Saxony, Bremen and East Frisia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 54–59 | 1972 | German Benedictus without organ; "Allein Gott" inside the Latin Gloria; Trinitarian German Sanctus; figured-music limit | 8.4.3, 8.6.1, 8.7.1, 8.12.2, 8.14.6, 8.18.8 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 143, 260–261 | 1974 | Latin for the scholars, German psalm for the people; "Dank sagen wir alle" or *Benedicamus* in the convents | 8.8.1, 8.16.9 |
| Braunschweig, Bugenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 6/1, pp. 438–442 | 1983 | Greek Kyrie defended; songs to rhyme with the feasts; psalm while communicants go to choir; Latin not forbidden | 8.6.3, 8.7.3, 8.9.2, 8.16.3, 8.18.2, 8.18.7 |
| Braunschweig, *Ordnung der ceremonien auf den dorfern*, undated | 6/1, p. 473 | 1988 | whole village service in hymns | 8.3.3, 8.15.3 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 543–545 | 2003 | litany-hymn after the epistle; baptism there; *Leisen* before the sermon | 8.8.9, 8.10.2 |
| Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555 | 6/1, p. 614 | 2009 | Latin and German Gloria by turns | 8.7.2 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 6/1, pp. 659, 663 | 2017 | creed without organ; *Leisen* as "motet"; deliverance-day hymns | 8.9.2, 8.10.2, 8.17.6 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, pp. 792–795, 814 | 2036 | village psalm for four chants; hymn "anstat des offertorii"; farced sequences; German Te Deum | 8.5.1, 8.8.3, 8.11.3, 8.16.4 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542, the German Masses | 6/2, pp. 820–825 | 2037 | German sequences; "Mit Fried und Freud" for the gradual; festal *Leise* for the offertory | 8.8.4, 8.8.5, 8.11.3, 8.12.1 |
| Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 | 6/2, pp. 924–926 | 2047 | chant while people gather; choice is free; *Da pacem* to close; German Te Deum | 8.4.2, 8.8.1, 8.15.3, 8.16.4 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1046, 1048 | 2058 | catechism hymn held through each part; Spangenberg's cantional | 8.16.6, 8.18.6 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1148–1151 | 2065 | German Te Deum at opening; *Leisen* in pulpit; festal closing hymns; Luther's hymns first | 8.4.4, 8.10.2, 8.15.3, 8.16.6, 8.18.5 |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1526 | 7/1, p. 70 | 2082 | seasonal hymn before the sermon | 8.10.1 |
| Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 7/1, pp. 74–78 | 2082 | introit kept if scriptural; creed as offertory without organ; organist to follow the choir | 8.5.1, 8.9.2, 8.15.3, 8.18.1, 8.18.9 |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, pp. 155–158 | 2090 | *Veni sancte* at the altar; gospel-matched psalm; *Leisen*; hymn while preacher vests | 8.4.1, 8.8.6, 8.10.2, 8.11.2 |
| Osnabrück (Stift), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 7/1, pp. 224–225 | 2096 | creed after the sermon; wedding Te Deum and Ps 128 | 8.9.2, 8.17.2 |
| Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 7/1, p. 258 | 2099 | "Allein Gott" inside the Latin Gloria | 8.7.1 |
| Ostfriesland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 7/1, pp. 376, 380 | 2107 | Kyrie and Gloria as in "Allein Gott"; Latin kept in honour; German psalm in place of the *Benedicamus* | 8.6.5, 8.16.9, 8.18.7 |
| Engerhafe, *Liturgie*, 1583 | 7/1, pp. 677–681 | 2119 | offertory hymn with organ; "O Lamm Gottes" split across the rite; communion hymns | 8.11.3, 8.13.2, 8.14.6 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593 | 7/1, pp. 695, 697 | 2120 | Kyrie "Ach Vater" and Te Deum at opening; hymn agreeing with the sermon | 8.4.4, 8.11.5 |
| Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 | 7/1, pp. 738–739 | 2122 | Luther's hymns first; no secular tunes; kneeling boys at the Sanctus | 8.12.2, 8.18.5, 8.18.9 |
| Hildesheim (Stift), *Kirchenordnung für Steuerwald und Peine*, 1561 | 7/2.1, pp. 781–783 | 2129 | German Te Deum at opening; *Leisen*; closing hymn | 8.4.4, 8.10.2, 8.15.3 |
| Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 7/2.1, pp. 852–856 | 2136 | hymn covering the prayers at the step and the devesting; Latin for the school | 8.4.6, 8.15.4, 8.16.3 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 1085–1089 | 2149 | sexton among the people for the German *Et in terra*; cantionals; "unfalsified" Luther songbook | 8.7.3, 8.18.6 |
| Goslar, Amsdorf, *Vom teglichen gots dinst*, 1528 | 7/2.2, pp. 237–238 | 2187 | burial singing left to the pastor | 8.17.4 |
| Goslar, SS. Simon and Jude, *Neugestaltung des Gottesdienstes*, 1560 | 7/2.2, p. 320 | 2204 | people sing while they gather for the sermon | 8.4.2 |
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 | 7/2.2, pp. 460–464 | 2217 | hymns until the last bell; creed as offertory; *O sacrum convivium*; organ as a trumpet | 8.4.2, 8.9.2, 8.14.5, 8.18.9 |
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561 | 7/2.2, pp. 510, 513 | 2221 | German songs until the people gather; Hus hymn in the old melody | 8.4.2, 8.14.1 |

**Schleswig-Holstein, Hamburg, Lauenburg and Hadeln, Mecklenburg, Livonia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Deutsche Messe* [after 1526] | 23, pp. 56–57 | 1576 | troped Low German Kyrie; stanzas of "Jesus Christus" between the actions | 8.6.4, 8.14.4 |
| Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528 | 23, p. 64 | 1576 | Latin sequences "with the *Leisen* in them" | 8.8.3 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, pp. 89–95, 143 | 1576 | German psalm for introit in villages; three sequences only; song stops with the communion; *O crux ave* condemned; Michaelmas Te Deum | 8.5.1, 8.8.2, 8.14.3, 8.16.1, 8.17.6 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 491, 516–530 | 1958, 1960 | "for the people's sake"; introits and joyful songs; farced sequences; creed as offertory; German Agnus; "Van singende"; wedding music | 8.3.4, 8.5.4, 8.8.3, 8.9.2, 8.14.4, 8.15.1, 8.16.3, 8.17.2, 8.18.1 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 553 | 1963 | organ between the verses; choir stops with the communion; *Da pacem* to close | 8.14.3, 8.15.3 |
| Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, pp. 557–558 | 1963 | prose "Komm heiliger Geist" for the introit; three German Kyries; "Erhalt uns" after sermon | 8.5.5, 8.6.4, 8.11.1 |
| Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 | 5, p. 408 | 1953 | installation hymns | 8.17.5 |
| Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526 | 5, p. 468 | 1955 | creed and psalm covering the preacher's movements | 8.9.3, 8.11.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 | 5, pp. 151–155 | 1922 | *Leise* as introit; German *Kyrie summum* taught to villages; organ-farced sequences; gospel-matched psalms; Sanctus forms; kneeling close | 8.5.4, 8.6.4, 8.8.3, 8.8.6, 8.11.5, 8.12.2, 8.14.3, 8.15.3 |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, pp. 199–201 | 1922 | *Leisen* from the pulpit; "Christe du Lamm" to close; hymns "that they may become known" | 8.10.2, 8.15.1, 8.18.4 |
| Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 | 5, pp. 288–290 | 1936 | psalm agreeing with the gospel; "Help Gott" at communion; Lossius and one melody | 8.11.5, 8.14.6, 8.17.4, 8.18.6 |
| Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 | 5, pp. 15, 17 | 1897 | Latin or German introit; Kyrie in three tongues; Lord's Prayer hymn at weekday communion | 8.5.1, 8.6.2, 8.13.1 |
| Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, pp. 88, 91, 105 | 1907 | litany-hymn after the epistle; *Leisen* intoned in the pulpit; catechism hymns for Latvians; burial hymns | 8.8.9, 8.10.2, 8.16.6, 8.17.4 |

**Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Pomerania, Poland, Transylvania**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1540 | 3, pp. 69–81 | 1746 | hymn at the elevation; village psalm for the offertory; *Discubuit* and German hymns; burial hymns by the course of the procession | 8.11.3, 8.12.3, 8.14.5, 8.17.4 |
| Brandenburg, *Visitations- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573 | 3, p. 109 | 1748 | installation hymns | 8.17.5 |
| Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603 | 3, p. 339 | 1788 | Christmas *Leise* until Candlemas | 8.10.3 |
| Liegnitz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 3, p. 439 | 1809 | creed after the sermon | 8.9.2 |
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592 | 3, pp. 445–446 | 1809 | Athanasian creed from Triller; hymns to agree with sermon, but known hymns not put under; Magnificat with *Resonet in laudibus* | 8.9.1, 8.10.4, 8.11.4, 8.16.10 |
| Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584 | 3, p. 462 | 1815 | German or Bohemian hymn for the introit | 8.5.1 |
| Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525 | 4, pp. 32–33 | 1832 | German psalms for introits; Kyrie in three tongues; Hus hymn and "Gott sei gelobet" | 8.5.1, 8.6.2, 8.14.1 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 4, pp. 64–65 | 1833 | rotating introit-psalms; alleluia and psalm list; hymn while priest "takes breath"; Sanctus while communicants come forward | 8.5.2, 8.8.7, 8.11.2, 8.12.1 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, pp. 75–84 | 1833 | Latin and German Gloria by turns; farced sequences; "Nun bitten" before, "Erhalt uns" after every sermon; Luther's hymns first | 8.7.2, 8.8.3, 8.9.1, 8.10.1, 8.11.1, 8.18.5 |
| Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557, in Sehling's summary | 4, p. 168 | 1844 | same hymns two Sundays running | 8.18.4 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 4, p. 237 | 1844 | hymn before sermon by text and need | 8.10.4 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4, pp. 340–344 | 1856 | German Benedictus; Ten Commandments or *Da pacem* while communicants gather; song stops | 8.4.3, 8.11.4, 8.14.3, 8.18.8 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Hymn practice | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | with communion; against long singing | |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 4, p. 356 | 1859 | Ps 51 for introit; lay "Allein Gott"; gospel-matched psalms; seasonal slot before sermon | 8.5.2, 8.7.2, 8.8.6, 8.10.3 |
| Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569 | 4, pp. 401–402 | 1862 | old festal songs, Latin and German, taught in the schools | 8.16.10 |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4, pp. 435–440 | 1865 | Te Deum for village introit; both German Glorias; gospel-matched psalm; Lossius; boys intone the Sanctus; organ at communion; closing hymns (table in `hymns.db`); *Benedicamus* by grade; *Da pacem* after it | 8.4.4, 8.5.2, 8.7.2, 8.8.6, 8.12.1, 8.14.7, 8.15.3, 8.16.2, 8.16.8, 8.16.9, 8.16.10 |
| Stralsund, draft *Kirchenordnung*, 1555 | 4, p. 551 | 1889 | two German Sanctus forms | 8.12.2 |
| Kronstadt, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543 | 24, p. 183 | 1666 | German songs after the epistle "if not repugnant to Scripture" | 8.8.1 |
| Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547 | 24, pp. 223–245 | 1669 | German Benedictus for the abolished procession; hymn before the sermon by season; office hymns of the season only | 8.4.3, 8.10.3, 8.16.1 |

## Appendix 8.A The chief hymn (*Hauptlied*) of each Sunday and feast in the old sources

This appendix condenses the **Compare by day** sheet of `hymns.xlsx`. That sheet lists every hymn that any witness in `hymns.db` assigns to a day, with the number of witnesses for each. Here the same evidence is cut down in two ways, so that the hymn of each day can be read at a glance:

- **Only the old sources are counted.** These are the church orders and hymnals of 1543–1694, the Leipzig usage of Bach's time, and the modern studies that do nothing but collate those older sources. The modern lists, from 1800 onward, are left out.
- **Only the hymns with significant support are given.** A day with one clear hymn shows that hymn alone. A day where support is divided shows each hymn with good support, and none of the hymns with only a few witnesses.

The word *Hauptlied* is later terminology and does not occur in the corpus (see §8.8 and the Introduction, The hymn database). The tables these witnesses keep are tables for the hymn of the day, which the orders place between the epistle and the gospel (§8.8.7) or before the sermon (§8.10.3).

### 8.A.1 The witnesses counted

Of the 48 witnesses in `hymns.db`, 29 are counted as old.

| Group | Witnesses |
|---|---|
| Sehling church orders (8) | Heilbronn 1543; Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565; Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569; Weissenfels 1578; Nördlingen 1579; Mansfeld 1580; Hof 1592; Hohenlohe 1596 |
| Hymnals collated in Liliencron's *de tempore* concordance (15) | Spangenberg 1545; Keuchenthal 1573; Selnecker; Gesius 1601; Leipzig *Geistliche Lieder* 1605; Stiphelius 1607; Augsburg 1619; Liegnitz 1625–30; Helmstedt 1626; Schein 1627; Erhardi, Frankfurt 1659; Schleswig-Holstein 1665; Darmstadt 1687; Goslar 1687; Leipzig *Kirchenandachten* 1694 |
| Other single orders and schemes (4) | Ludecus, *Ordo cantionum Germanicarum*, 1589; Carpzov (the hymns on which he preached); the *de tempore* plan of c. 1700 printed by Graff; Bach's Leipzig usage (the chorales of his Sunday and festival cantatas) |

| Group | Witnesses |
|---|---|
| Modern studies that collate older sources (2) | Stiller (the Leipzig, Weissenfels and Dresden hymn schedules of Bach's time); Thompson, dissertation, Appendix 2 (Ludecus with twelve other 16th-century lists) |

The other 19 witnesses are modern and are **not counted**. Krusemark explains his own lists on pp. 95–96 of `Hymns_ABC_Krusemark.pdf`. The modern witnesses are:

- Krusemark's Years A, B and C;
- the lists of Stuckwisch, Reuning, Gehrke, Eckardt, Judisch, Zion (Detroit) and Redeemer;
- the LCMS Synod selections of 2016–17 and the LSB Hymnal Committee;
- *Lutheran Worship* (1982), *Lutheran Service Book* (2006) and the SELK hymnal;
- the Mecklenburg hymnal of 1855;
- two private schemes (MC, SD) and the unattributed entries.

Some of the old witnesses reach `hymns.db` through modern compilations. Carpzov, Bach and the plan of c. 1700 come through Krusemark or the Hymn of the Day table, and Selnecker through all three. Each is counted once, as a witness, whichever book it was read from (Introduction, The hymn database).

Some of the old witnesses add nothing to the table, for these reasons:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1565.** Its table is a three-week rotating cycle, not tied to particular Sundays, so it falls outside this table.
- **Heilbronn 1543, Nördlingen 1579 and Hof 1592.** They assign Latin office hymns. These count among the witnesses for their days but never reach the threshold.

#### 8.A.2 How the table was made

- **Counting is by witness.** A hymn's figure is the number of old witnesses that assign it to the day. "11 of 18" means that 11 of the 18 old witnesses that give any hymn for that day give this one.
- **One hymn, one row.** Spellings, Low German forms and English titles of the same hymn are joined, as in the workbook. English-only citations from Carpzov, Selnecker, Bach, the plan of c. 1700 and Thompson are joined to their German hymns. "The Day Is Surely Drawing Near", for example, is joined to *Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit*. The hymn database does this joining with its lexicon of hymns and its table of English titles, so `hymns.db` and the workbook group the hymns as this table does.
- **Hymns with the same or a similar opening are kept apart:**
  - Eber's *Herr Gott, dich loben alle wir*, on the angels, is kept apart from Luther's German Te Deum *Herr Gott, dich loben wir*. Liliencron himself insists on this distinction.
  - Luther's Easter hymn *Jesus Christus, unser Heiland, der den Tod überwand* is kept apart from his Communion hymn of the same opening. A source that prints only the opening words for an Easter occasion is read as meaning the Easter hymn.
  - *Als Jesus Christus, Gottes Sohn* is kept apart from *Jesus Christus, wahrer Gottes Sohn*.
  - *Mag ich dem Tod nicht widerstahn* is kept apart from *Mag ich Unglück nicht widerstahn*.
- **Grouped entries are shared out.** An entry for "Lent 1–3" or "Lent 5, Palm Sunday and Good Friday" counts for each of the days it names. The last Sundays after Trinity are given together, as most of the hymnals give them ("Trinity 25–27"). Entries for a whole season ("Advent", "Lent", "Easter season") and the Pfalz-Zweibrücken cycle are not counted.
- **Which hymns are shown.** A hymn is shown for a day when it meets all three of these conditions:
  - it has at least three witnesses;
  - it has at least three fifths of the witnesses of the day's leading hymn;
  - it has at least a quarter of the witnesses that give any hymn for that day.

On Advent 1, *Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland* has 20 witnesses and no other hymn more than 7, so it stands alone. On Advent 2, *Gott hat das Evangelium* (11), *Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit* (8) and *Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun* (8) are shown. *Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen* (6), *Ach Gott, thu dich erbarmen* (5) and *Nun komm* (4) are not.

- **Days the witnesses leave open.** On Quasimodogeniti, Maundy Thursday, Easter Monday and Pentecost Monday no hymn has three old witnesses. For these four days the table gives the hymn assigned by the editor of the corpus, marked ‡, with the number of old witnesses that do give it. The assignments are kept in a table of their own in `hymns.db`, and flagged "Assigned" in the Compare by day sheet. They are not prescriptions and are not counted as witnesses.
- **Titles.**
  - **Original title:** the hymn's standard spelling from the `hymns` lexicon.
  - **Literal English:** a word-for-word rendering of the incipit.
  - **Common English title:** the received English title. Where the hymn has none, the title of Matthew Carver's translation is given and marked †. These come from *Walther's Hymnal* (2012), which Carver translated, or from his blog *Hymnoglypt* (Introduction, The hymn database). The title is "—" where neither exists.

### 8.A.3 The table

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Advent 1** | *Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland* | Now come, Savior of the heathen | Savior of the Nations, Come | 20 of 23 |
| **Advent 2** | *Gott hat das Evangelium* | God has given the gospel | God Gave the Gospel That We May † | 11 of 18 |
| | *Es ist gewisslich an der Zeit* | It is surely time | The Day Is Surely Drawing Near | 8 of 18 |
| | *Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun* | Ye dear Christians, rejoice now | Rejoice, Rejoice, Ye Christians Dear † | 8 of 18 |
| **Advent 3** | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 11 of 18 |
| | *Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland* | Now come, Savior of the heathen | Savior of the Nations, Come | 9 of 18 |
| **Advent 4** | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 11 of 15 |
| | *Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam* | Christ our Lord came to the Jordan | To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord | 7 of 15 |
| **Christmas Day** | *Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ* | Praised be thou, Jesus Christ | All Praise to Thee, Eternal Lord | 20 of 25 |
| | *Christum wir sollen loben schon* | Christ we should indeed praise | Now Praise We Christ, the Holy One | 17 of 25 |
| | *Vom Himmel hoch da komm ich her* | From heaven high I come here | From Heaven Above to Earth I Come | 17 of 25 |
| | *Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich* | The day that is so full of joy | Hail This Joyous Day | 16 of 25 |
| | *Vom Himmel kam der Engel Schar* | From heaven came the host of angels | To Shepherds as They Watched by Night | 15 of 25 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *In dulci jubilo* | In sweet rejoicing | Good Christian Men, Rejoice | 13 of 25 |
| **Sunday after Christmas** | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 4 of 10 |
| | *Hilf Gott, wie geht das immer zu* | Help God, how does this ever go on | Oh, Help Us, God! Why Must It Be † | 4 of 10 |
| | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 3 of 10 |
| **New Year (Circumcision)** | *Helft mir Gotts Güte preisen* | Help me praise God's goodness | To God the Anthem Raising † | 8 of 16 |
| | *Das alte Jahr vergangen ist* | The old year has passed | The Old Year Now Hath Passed Away | 6 of 16 |
| **Sunday after New Year** | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 3 of 3 |
| **Epiphany** | *Was fürchtst du, Feind Herodes, sehr* | Why dost thou fear so, foe Herod | Why, Herod, Unrelenting Foe | 18 of 25 |
| **Epiphany 1** | *Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot* | These are the holy ten commandments | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | 13 of 17 |
| | *Mensch, willst du leben seliglich* | Man, wouldst thou live blessedly | Man, Wouldst Thou Live All Blissfully | 8 of 17 |
| **Epiphany 2** | *Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht* | Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God | Blessed Are They Who Fear the Lord | 13 of 17 |
| **Epiphany 3** | *Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ | I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ | 7 of 17 |
| **Epiphany 4** | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 11 of 18 |
| | *Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit* | Were God not with us at this time | Were God Not with Us at This Time | 8 of 18 |
| **Epiphany 5** | *Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* | O God, look down from heaven | O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold | 10 of 15 |
| **Epiphany 6** | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 7 of 11 |
| | *Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein* | May God be gracious to us | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | 5 of 11 |
| **Septuagesima** | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 14 of 23 |
| **Sexagesima** | *Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* | O God, look down from heaven | O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold | 7 of 19 |
| | *Es spricht der Unweisen Mund wohl* | The mouth of the unwise says indeed | The Mouth of Fools Doth God Confess | 7 of 19 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *Kommt her zu mir, spricht Gottes Sohn* | Come here to me, says God's Son | Come unto Me, Ye Weary | 6 of 19 |
| | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 5 of 19 |
| **Quinquagesima (Estomihi)** | *Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt* | Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted | All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall | 3 of 9 |
| | *Herr Jesu Christ, wahr Mensch und Gott* | Lord Jesus Christ, true man and God | Lord Jesus Christ, True Man and God | 3 of 9 |
| **Lent 1 (Invocavit)** | *Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott* | A firm fortress is our God | A Mighty Fortress Is Our God | 16 of 20 |
| | *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* | God the Father, dwell with us | God the Father, Be Our Stay | 12 of 20 |
| | *Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht* | Christ, thou who art day and light | O Christ, Who Art the Light and Day | 11 of 20 |
| **Lent 2 (Reminiscere)** | *Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ | I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ | 11 of 16 |
| | *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* | God the Father, dwell with us | God the Father, Be Our Stay | 8 of 16 |
| | *Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht* | Christ, thou who art day and light | O Christ, Who Art the Light and Day | 7 of 16 |
| | *Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott* | A firm fortress is our God | A Mighty Fortress Is Our God | 7 of 16 |
| **Lent 3 (Oculi)** | *Ein feste Burg ist unser Gott* | A firm fortress is our God | A Mighty Fortress Is Our God | 14 of 18 |
| | *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* | God the Father, dwell with us | God the Father, Be Our Stay | 10 of 18 |
| **Lent 4 (Laetare)** | *Vater unser im Himmelreich* | Our Father in the kingdom of heaven | Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above | 6 of 17 |
| | *Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz* | Why art thou troubled, my heart | Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart | 6 of 17 |
| | *Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt* | Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted | All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall | 5 of 17 |
| | *O Mensch, bewein dein Sünde groß* | O man, bewail thy great sin | O Man, Bewail Thy Grievous Sin | 5 of 17 |
| **Lent 5 (Judica)** | *Christus, der uns selig macht* | Christ, who makes us blessed | Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross † | 4 of 14 |
| | *Da Jesus an dem Kreuze stund* | When Jesus on the cross stood | When Jesus on the Cross Was Bound | 4 of 14 |
| | *O Lamm Gottes, unschuldig* | O Lamb of God, innocent | Lamb of God, Pure and Holy | 4 of 14 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 4 of 14 |
| **Palm Sunday** | *Christus, der uns selig macht* | Christ, who makes us blessed | Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross † | 5 of 16 |
| | *Hilf Gott, dass mir gelinge* | Help, God, that I may succeed | Assist Me, Great Creator † | 5 of 16 |
| | *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein* | Now rejoice, dear Christians together | Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice | 4 of 16 |
| **Maundy Thursday** | *Jesus Christus, unser Heiland* | Jesus Christ, our Savior | Jesus Christ, Our Blessed Savior | 2 of 3 ‡ |
| **Good Friday** | *Da Jesus an dem Kreuze stund* | When Jesus on the cross stood | When Jesus on the Cross Was Bound | 10 of 12 |
| | *Christus, der uns selig macht* | Christ, who makes us blessed | Christ, Who Saves Us by His Cross † | 6 of 12 |
| **Easter Day** | *Christ ist erstanden* | Christ is risen | Christ Is Arisen | 18 of 22 |
| | *Christ lag in Todesbanden* | Christ lay in death's bonds | Christ Jesus Lay in Death's Strong Bands | 17 of 22 |
| | *Jesus Christus, unser Heiland, der den Tod überwand* | Jesus Christ, our Saviour, who overcame death | Jesus Christ, Our Savior and King † | 15 of 22 |
| | *Erstanden ist der heilige Christ* | The holy Christ is risen | — | 14 of 22 |
| **Easter Monday** | *Ach bleib bei uns, Herr Jesu Christ* | Abide with us, Lord Jesus Christ | Lord Jesus Christ, with Us Abide | 1 of 2 ‡ |
| | *Christ ist erstanden* | Christ is risen | Christ Is Arisen | 1 of 2 ‡ |
| **Easter 1 (Quasimodogeniti)** | *O filii et filiae* | O sons and daughters | O Sons and Daughters of the King | 1 of 6 ‡ |
| **Easter 2 (Misericordias Domini)** | *Der Herr ist mein getreuer Hirt* | The Lord is my faithful shepherd | The Lord’s My Shepherd, Faithful, True | 11 of 14 |
| **Easter 3 (Jubilate)** | *Kommt her zu mir, spricht Gottes Sohn* | Come here to me, says God's Son | Come unto Me, Ye Weary | 9 of 13 |
| | *Mag ich Unglück nicht widerstahn* | If I cannot withstand misfortune | May I My Fate No More Withstand † | 6 of 13 |
| **Easter 4 (Cantate)** | *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein* | Now rejoice, dear Christians together | Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice | 11 of 14 |
| **Easter 5 (Rogate)** | *Vater unser im Himmelreich* | Our Father in the kingdom of heaven | Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above | 16 of 17 |
| **Ascension** | *Christ fuhr gen Himmel* | Christ went up to heaven | Christ Went Up to Heaven | 17 of 23 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein* | Now rejoice, dear Christians together | Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice | 11 of 23 |
| **Sunday after Ascension (Exaudi)** | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 12 of 13 |
| **Pentecost** | *Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott* | Come, Holy Spirit, Lord God | Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord | 21 of 23 |
| | *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist* | Now we pray to the Holy Spirit | We Now Implore God the Holy Ghost | 19 of 23 |
| | *Komm, Gott Schöpfer, Heiliger Geist* | Come, God Creator, Holy Spirit | Come, Holy Ghost, Creator Blest | 13 of 23 |
| **Pentecost Monday** | *Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott* | Come, Holy Spirit, Lord God | Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord | 1 of 2 ‡ |
| **Trinity Sunday** | *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei* | God the Father, dwell with us | God the Father, Be Our Stay | 21 of 24 |
| **Trinity 1** | *Es war einmal ein reicher Mann* | There was once a rich man | There Was a Rich and Wealthy Man † | 11 of 19 |
| **Trinity 2** | *Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* | O God, look down from heaven | O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold | 13 of 22 |
| | *Es spricht der Unweisen Mund wohl* | The mouth of the unwise says indeed | The Mouth of Fools Doth God Confess | 13 of 22 |
| | *Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein* | May God be gracious to us | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | 8 of 22 |
| **Trinity 3** | *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* | Have mercy on me, O Lord God | Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God | 12 of 19 |
| | *Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ | In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord | 8 of 19 |
| **Trinity 4** | *Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot* | These are the holy ten commandments | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | 15 of 21 |
| | *Mensch, willst du leben seliglich* | Man, wouldst thou live blessedly | Man, Wouldst Thou Live All Blissfully | 9 of 21 |
| **Trinity 5** | *Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst* | If God does not give his favour to the house | Unless the Lord Builds Up the House | 12 of 20 |
| **Trinity 6** | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 19 of 21 |
| | *Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt* | Through Adam's fall all is wholly corrupted | All Mankind Fell in Adam’s Fall | 12 of 21 |
| **Trinity 7** | *Vater unser im Himmelreich* | Our Father in the kingdom of heaven | Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above | 12 of 21 |
| | *Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz* | Why art thou troubled, my heart | Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart | 12 of 21 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | *Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht* | Blessed is he who stands in the fear of God | Blessed Are They Who Fear the Lord | 8 of 21 |
| **Trinity 8** | *Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* | O God, look down from heaven | O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold | 19 of 22 |
| **Trinity 9** | *Es wolle Gott uns gnädig sein* | May God be gracious to us | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | 8 of 21 |
| | *Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot* | These are the holy ten commandments | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | 6 of 21 |
| | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 6 of 21 |
| | *Weltlich Ehr und zeitlich Gut* | Worldly honour and temporal goods | — | 6 of 21 |
| **Trinity 10** | *An Wasserflüssen Babylon* | By the waters of Babylon | By the Waters of Babylon | 17 of 21 |
| **Trinity 11** | *Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir* | Out of deep distress I cry to thee | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | 14 of 22 |
| | *Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ | In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord | 12 of 22 |
| | *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* | Have mercy on me, O Lord God | Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God | 10 of 22 |
| | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 9 of 22 |
| **Trinity 12** | *Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren* | Now praise the Lord, my soul | My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker | 12 of 19 |
| **Trinity 13** | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 17 of 19 |
| **Trinity 14** | *Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren* | Now praise the Lord, my soul | My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker | 12 of 17 |
| | *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* | Have mercy on me, O Lord God | Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God | 8 of 17 |
| **Trinity 15** | *Vater unser im Himmelreich* | Our Father in the kingdom of heaven | Our Father, Thou in Heaven Above | 14 of 19 |
| | *Warum betrübst du dich, mein Herz* | Why art thou troubled, my heart | Why Art Thou Thus Cast Down, My Heart | 14 of 19 |
| **Trinity 16** | *Mitten wir im Leben sind* | In the midst of life we are | In the Very Midst of Life | 15 of 22 |
| **Trinity 17** | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 14 of 20 |
| | *Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit* | Were God not with us at this time | Were God Not with Us at This Time | 9 of 20 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Trinity 18** | *Es ist das Heil uns kommen her* | Salvation has come to us | Salvation unto Us Has Come | 13 of 18 |
| | *Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot* | These are the holy ten commandments | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | 11 of 18 |
| | *Herr Christ, der einig Gotts Sohn* | Lord Christ, the only Son of God | The Only Son from Heaven | 8 of 18 |
| | *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein* | Now rejoice, dear Christians together | Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice | 8 of 18 |
| **Trinity 19** | *Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ | In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord | 12 of 19 |
| | *Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir* | Out of deep distress I cry to thee | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | 11 of 19 |
| **Trinity 20** | *Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein* | O God, look down from heaven | O Lord, Look Down from Heaven, Behold | 12 of 19 |
| **Trinity 21** | *Ich ruf zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | I call to thee, Lord Jesus Christ | I Call to Thee, Lord Jesus Christ | 11 of 18 |
| **Trinity 22** | *Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir* | Out of deep distress I cry to thee | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | 14 of 20 |
| | *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott* | Have mercy on me, O Lord God | Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God | 13 of 20 |
| **Trinity 23** | *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* | If God the Lord does not stand by us | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | 13 of 18 |
| | *Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit* | Were God not with us at this time | Were God Not with Us at This Time | 10 of 18 |
| **Trinity 24** | *Mitten wir im Leben sind* | In the midst of life we are | In the Very Midst of Life | 9 of 19 |
| | *Allein zu dir, Herr Jesu Christ* | In thee alone, Lord Jesus Christ | In Thee Alone, O Christ, My Lord | 8 of 19 |
| | *Herr Jesu Christ, wahr Mensch und Gott* | Lord Jesus Christ, true man and God | Lord Jesus Christ, True Man and God | 8 of 19 |
| | *Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin* | With peace and joy I depart | In Peace and Joy I Now Depart | 6 of 19 |
| **Trinity 25–27 (the last Sundays)** | *Gott hat das Evangelium* | God has given the gospel | God Gave the Gospel That We May † | 9 of 18 |
| | *Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen* | The last day will soon be coming | Lo, the Final Day Is Fast Approaching † | 7 of 18 |
| | *Ihr lieben Christen, freut euch nun* | Ye dear Christians, rejoice now | Rejoice, Rejoice, Ye Christians Dear † | 6 of 18 |
| **Purification of Mary (2 Feb)** | *Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin* | With peace and joy I depart | In Peace and Joy I Now Depart | 22 of 23 |

| Sunday or feast | Original title | Literal English | Common English title | Witnesses |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Annunciation (25 March)** | *Mein Seel erhebt den Herren* | My soul magnifies the Lord | My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord | 16 of 18 |
| **St John the Baptist (24 June)** | *Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam* | Christ our Lord came to the Jordan | To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord | 9 of 17 |
| | *Gelobet sei der Herr, der Gott Israel* | Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel | Blessed Be the Lord, the God of Israel | 9 of 17 |
| **Visitation of Mary (2 July)** | *Mein Seel erhebt den Herren* | My soul magnifies the Lord | My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord | 6 of 8 |
| **St Michael (29 Sept)** | *Nun lob, mein Seel, den Herren* | Now praise the Lord, my soul | My Soul, Now Praise Thy Maker | 10 of 16 |
| | *Herr Gott, dich loben alle wir* | Lord God, we all praise thee | Lord God, We All to Thee Give Praise | 8 of 16 |

† Title of Matthew Carver's translation, in *Walther's Hymnal* (2012) or on his blog *Hymnoglypt*; the hymn has no received English title.

‡ Assigned by the editor; the old witnesses leave the day open (see §8.A.2). The figure is the number of old witnesses that do give this hymn.

### 8.A.4 Notes on the table

- **Days not in the table.** The saints' days not listed (St Paul, St Mary Magdalene, St Lawrence, St Martin, All Saints and others) have one old witness or two.
- **The assigned days.** Quasimodogeniti is the one Sunday the old witnesses leave open: Liliencron's concordance records only a single coincidence for it, and no hymn has more than two old witnesses. Only two or three old witnesses give a hymn for Maundy Thursday and the second feast days of Easter and Pentecost. The hymns assigned to these days (‡) are mostly the ones those few witnesses give: Luther's Communion hymn on Maundy Thursday (Carpzov, Selnecker), *Ach bleib bei uns* and *Christ ist erstanden* on Easter Monday (Bach's Leipzig), and *Komm, Heiliger Geist* on Pentecost Monday (Stiller). *O filii et filiae* on Quasimodogeniti has one old witness (Stiller) and is the usual choice of the modern lists.
- **Thin days.** On some days the evidence is divided or sparse, and the "of" figure should be read with the count:
  - the Sunday after Christmas;
  - the Sunday after New Year (three witnesses in all);
  - Quinquagesima;
  - Lent 4 and 5;
  - Palm Sunday.
- **One possible double count.** Thompson's column collates Ludecus with twelve other lists and cannot be separated from Ludecus's own entries (Introduction, The hymn database). Where both support a hymn, Ludecus may be counted twice. Thompson is kept, because it is a modern study that collates old sources. Without it, the leading hymn of every day except Lent 4 and Trinity 7, 15 and 24 would stay the same, and on those four days the leading hymns are tied or nearly tied. The hymns at the margin would change on 15 days. For example:
  - Trinity 4 would lose *Mensch, willst du leben seliglich*;
  - Advent 2 would gain *Es wird schier der letzte Tag herkommen*;
  - Ascension would gain *Nun freut euch, Gottes Kinder, all*.
- **What the table shows.**
  - The core of the old *de tempore* scheme is very stable. On 36 of the 64 days whose hymn the witnesses choose, one hymn has at least two thirds of the day's witnesses. Examples:
    - Advent 1, *Nun komm*;
    - Epiphany, *Was fürchtst du, Feind Herodes*;
    - Easter 5, the Lord's Prayer hymn;

        - Exaudi, *Wo Gott der Herr*;
        - Pentecost, *Komm, Heiliger Geist*;
        - Trinity Sunday, *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei*;
        - Trinity 6 and 13, *Es ist das Heil*;
        - Trinity 8, *Ach Gott, vom Himmel*;
        - Trinity 10, *An Wasserflüssen Babylon*;
        - the Purification, *Mit Fried und Freud*;
        - the Annunciation, the German Magnificat.
    - The same hymns return on several Sundays:
        - *Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält* and *Wär Gott nicht mit uns* on Epiphany 4, Trinity 17 and Trinity 23;
        - *Vater unser* and *Warum betrübst du dich* together on Trinity 7 and 15;
        - *Aus tiefer Not*, *Allein zu dir* and *Erbarm dich mein* among Trinity 3, 11, 19 and 22.

# Chapter 9. Organ, Instruments and Bells

This chapter covers instrumental music and sounded signals in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks:

- **The organ.** Was it kept? Did the organist play a prelude before the service or before a hymn, interludes between the verses or the parts of the service, or a postlude after the blessing? When was it silent? What might the organist not play?
- **Other instruments.** Were instruments other than the organ played in church? If so, which, when, and by whom?
- **Bells.** Which bells were rung: tower bells, a choir bell, a little bell or handbell at the altar, a Sanctus bell? When were they rung: before church, at the canonical hours, at the consecration and elevation, at the Sanctus, during the Lord's Prayer, at the *Gloria in excelsis* on Easter Day, during certain hymns, for the dead, at baptisms and weddings, against storms?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §9.1 answers each question in brief, and §9.2 sets out the scope and sources.
- §9.3 covers the organ: its defence and its limits, the prelude, the alternation of organ and singers, the postlude, the seasons and rites in which it was silent, and the organist.
- §9.4 covers the other instruments: trombones, town pipers and fiddlers, the carillon and the tower-blower, and the minstrels of weddings.
- §9.5 covers the bells: their purpose, the summons to church, the daily and prayer bells, bells within the Mass, bells at hymns and the litany, the dead, baptisms and weddings, storms, and the lesser signals of sermon and alms.
- §9.6 is a table by order, and §9.7 a concordance of every order quoted.

**Related chapters.** Several passages are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the organ and polyphony at the introit and other propers: Chapter 4, §§4.4.5, 4.10.4–4.10.5;
- the organ and figural music at the office: Chapter 10, §10.9.4;
- choir, people and organ in the hymns: Chapter 8, §§8.14.7, 8.18.9;
- figural music, the organ and bells as marks of feast rank: Chapter 12, §§12.10.5, 12.10.7;
- bell baptism and weather-ringing, and the organist's contract: Chapter 13, §§13.12.3, 13.15.5;
- the bell-ringer's appointment and pledge: Chapter 13, §13.12.2;
- the length of the sermon that the sermon glass measured: Chapter 11, §11.7.

## 9.1 Summary of findings

**The organ**

1. **Kept by the Lutherans, kept out of the service by the Reformed.** Luther would have "all the organs piped" if it served the young (1526). No Lutheran order abolishes the organ. Wittenberg's castle church in 1525 limits it to the Sunday *Te Deum* and German songs. Strasbourg in 1598 defends "singing and organ-playing" against the Reformed, who cast them out as "papistical leaven". Reformed Emden (1594) keeps its organ but uses it only before the service, while the people gather, and after it, as they leave (§9.3.1).
2. **Preludes: yes, of two kinds** (§9.3.2).
    - **A voluntary while the people gather.** At Strasbourg 1598 the organist begins "at the end of the last ringing"; at Emden 1594 (Reformed), "before nine o'clock, when the people gather".
    - **Announcing each piece.** The organist begins a chant or plays the first stanza of a hymn, and the choir or people take it up (Gelnhausen [1568], Naumburg 1537/38, Nördlingen 1555, Schweinfurt 1576, Hof 1592).
    - Strasbourg requires the prelude to be "even that which the congregation shall afterward sing", not "strange pieces and motets".
    - The practice of the organist "preambulating" before every item belongs to the seventeenth century (Bischofswerda 1676).
3. **Interludes: yes, chiefly as alternation** (§9.3.3).
    - **The usual form.** The organ plays a verse or stanza in turn with choir and people, and the verse it plays is usually not sung (Regensburg 1553, Naumburg, Nördlingen, Prussia 1568, Pomerania 1569, Hof). At Regensburg's Vespers, though, "all the verses [are] nevertheless sung wholly throughout, for the better understanding".

- **Limits on the organ's share.** Strasbourg allows "once or at the most twice" in a hymn; Reutlingen 1574, one stanza after every two sung. At Bergedorf 1544 the people first sing the whole psalm. Schleswig-Holstein 1542 has the German hymns sung "without organ".
- **Pieces between the parts of the service.** These are separate from the alternation (§9.3.4). Schönburg 1542 has them after the epistle, after the Creed, and after the sermon "until the priest come to the altar". Schweinfurt 1576 has one in place of the *Et in terra*.

4. **Postludes: yes** (§9.3.5).
   - **After the blessing.** Strasbourg allows "other pieces" or Latin motets for those who wish to stay.
   - **Elsewhere.** Gelnhausen: "Let the organist close with a little piece". Schönburg: "a good piece" after communion. Prussia 1568: a piece after the *Nunc dimittis*. Hamburg 1556: "before and after the sermon". Emden 1594 (Reformed): as the people leave.
5. **Silent seasons and rites** (§9.3.6).
   - **Seasons.** Lent or Passiontide (Hamburg 1529, Nördlingen 1555); Advent II to Christmas Eve (Hof 1592); Rogation week (Pomerania 1569); lower feasts (Henneberg 1582).
   - **Rites.** The litany (Henneberg 1582); communion (Wolfenbüttel 1543, Schönburg 1542 except on high feasts, Reutlingen 1574); baptism (Thorn 1560–1570).
   - **Forbidden music.** Worldly songs, love-songs, dances and galliards (Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Hamburg 1556, Pomerania 1569, Stettin 1573, Emden 1577 (Reformed)) (§9.3.7).

**Other instruments**

6. **Rare, and tied to figural music, courts, towns and weddings** (§9.4).
   - **Trombones.** "Trombones and other such instruments" accompany the psalms at the Ansbach court in 1538, and at weddings in church.
   - **Town pipers and fiddlers.** Danzig in 1612 retains the town pipers (three masters, three journeymen) and three fiddlers "for the choir", to play whenever there is figural music.
   - **Emden** (Reformed). The organist-town-piper of 1577 serves with "Christian music and other instruments" on feast days, tends the carillon and blows from the town-hall tower. The editor's notes add trombone-playing "in the organ" (1579), and a tower-watchman's psalms on cornett and trombone (1679).
   - **Wedding minstrels.** Pipes, fiddles, drums and trumpets play the bridal party to the churchyard (Hamburg 1529). They must not disturb the sermon (Nassau-Dillenburg 1570, Herford 1532), and they are withheld from a bride who has lost her honour (Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615).
   - **Not found.** No order names a lute, regal, cornett or trumpet in the service itself.

**Bells**

7. **Purpose.** Bells call people to the Word and to prayer, not to "the pomp of the feasts" (Wittenberg 1525, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585). Some orders curbed festal chiming (Danzig 1567, Bentheim 1601 (Reformed)); most kept more bells for greater days (Altenburg 1533, Danzig 1612) (§9.5.1).
8. **Before church.** The usual summons is three signs, the last "together", or three with one bell and a little bell last (Gelnhausen [1568], Esslingen 1540 (Moderate Reformed), Bentheim 1601 (Reformed)). Danzig 1612 names its seven bells and gives the full Sunday and weekday ringing (§9.5.2).
9. **At the canonical hours and through the day** (§9.5.3).
   - **Morning and evening, and the prayer bell.** The ringing at morning and evening was kept, even where no Matins or Vespers was held (Prussia 1544). It was reinterpreted as a bell *pro pace*, for peace, government and against the Turk. Many orders also rang at noon or eleven (Saxony 1528, Allstedt 1533, Meissen 1540, Wolfenbüttel 1543, Kurpfalz 1546, Lüneburg 1564, Hoya 1581, with its prayer). It also served as a time-signal for workers.
   - **The Ave Maria and Salve.** These names were dropped or the ringing recast (Heilbronn 1532, Coburg 1554/55, Lichtenberg 1579).
   - **The Friday bell for the Passion.** Kept by some (Kurpfalz 1546, Thüngen 1564), abolished with the *Tenebrae* ringing by others (Hohenlohe 1582).
10. **At the elevation and consecration** (§9.5.4).
    - **A sign with the little bell before the consecration.** Prussia 1525, Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570.
    - **Ringing at the elevation.** The Danish *Ordinatio* of 1537 allows it, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom". The Interim restored it at Ansbach (1548). At Hof it lasted until about 1560, "with a threefold pulse of the

little bell".

11. **At the Sanctus.** Only Hatzkerode (1534?) rings a bell during the German Sanctus, and that is to call the communicants into the choir. There is no "Sanctus bell" in the corpus (§9.5.4).
12. **During the Lord's Prayer.** Not in the Mass. The Our Father is tied to the bell only in the daily prayer bells and the Friday bell (§9.5.4).
13. **At the *Gloria in excelsis* on Easter.** Not found (§9.5.4).
14. **During hymns and chants** (§9.5.5).
    - **The *Te Deum*.** Ringing to call the people to the sermon and Mass (Prussia 1544 and 1568). All the bells at the Christmas *Te Deum* (Hof 1592).
    - **The litany.** The greatest bell so that those in the field may join in (Hohenlohe 1582), or singing "under the ringing" (Regensburg 1567).
    - **Not found.** No order rings during a particular stanza.
15. **For the dead** (§9.5.6).
    - **Kept as a call to the living.** "That the living also may consider the hour of their own dying" (Meissen 1540).
    - **Abolished.** The Saturday ringing "for all faithful souls" (Zwickau 1529, Reuss 1552).
    - **Regulated.** Equality (Ulm, Moderate Reformed), fees by the number of bells (Danzig 1578), silence during sermons (Herford 1532).
    - **Withheld.** From despisers of the Sacrament (Zwickau 1533) and from unbaptized infants (Lippe 1571).
16. **At baptisms and weddings** (§9.5.7).
    - **Baptism.** A new evangelical custom: a sign with a bell, often the little bell, calls the congregation to a baptism held outside the regular service (Heilbronn c. 1529, Kurpfalz 1556, Ansbach 1556, Limpurg 1610).
    - **Weddings.** At Hof the bell is rung half an hour later than usual.
17. **Against storms.** Kept as a call to prayer by some, abolished by most (§9.5.8; see Chapter 13, §13.15.5).
18. **Small bells.** A little bell in the choir calls the scholars (Prussia 1568); a little bell calls communicants (Haldensleben 1564); a little bell ends the sermon when the hour-glass runs out (Zerbst 1545); and a hand-bell accompanies the alms collection during sermons (Brandis 1529). Little bells at the Sacrament were rejected by the Reformed (Micron) and at Transylvanian sick-communions (§§9.5.4, 9.5.9).

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## 9.2 Scope, sources and method

**Sources.** The chapter draws on the whole of Sehling's edition as held in `eko.db`: volumes 1–24, including the half-volumes, with the editors' introductions and notes. Passages from an editor's introduction or note are marked as such, and so are witnesses later than about 1615, which are cited only for comparison: Bischofswerda 1676, and the Emden tower-watchman of 1679 (Reformed).

**Searches.** The corpus was searched for:

- **The organ and organist**: *orgel*, *orgeln*, *organist*, *organicen*, *organum*, *präambulieren*, *schlagen* near a chant or hymn.
- **Other instruments**: *posaune/basune*, *zinke*, *pfeifer*, *fidler/geige*, *laute*, *trommete/trompete*, *pauke*, *bunge*, *saitenspiel*, *spielleute*, *instrument*, *klockenspil*, *cymbala*.
- **Bells**: *glocke*, *glöcklein*, *schelle*, *campana/campanula*, *leuten/läuten/lüden*, *beiern*, *puls*, *zeichen*, *pro pace*, *betglocke*, *Ave Maria*, *Salve*, *wetterleuten*, *tenebre*, *schiedung*.

Because *leuten* ("ring") is spelled like *Leute* ("people") in many of the orders, ringing passages were found by searching for a bell word within a few words of a ringing verb, and of the Mass item in question (Sanctus, elevation, consecration, *Pater noster*, *Gloria*, *Te Deum*, litany, baptism, burial, wedding, storm).

**Negative findings.** Several things the chapter reports as "not found" were searched for directly:

- a "Sanctus bell" (*Sanctusglocke* or any compound), a *Wandlungsglocke*, a hand-bell (*Handglocke*);
- ringing during the Lord's Prayer of the Mass;
- ringing at the Easter *Gloria in excelsis*;
- ringing at a named stanza of a hymn;
- a regal, a lute, a cornett or a trumpet in the service.

A passage phrased in an unexpected way may have escaped these searches. The negatives mean only that no such passage was found.

**What the chapter does not repeat.** The chapter does not repeat what is quoted in full elsewhere; see the related chapters listed at the head of this chapter.

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## 9.3 The organ

### 9.3.1 Kept, and defended

**Luther.** Luther's preface to the *Deutsche Messe* names the organ in the same breath as the bells, as means that may serve the teaching of the young. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 11):

> umb solcher willen mus man lesen, singen, predigen, schreiben und tichten, und wo es hulflich und fodderlich dazu were, wolt ich lassen mit allen glocken dazu leuten und mit allen orgeln pfeiffen und alles klingen lassen, was klingen kunde.

for the sake of such must one read, sing, preach, write and make verses; and where it were helpful and furthering thereto, I would have all the bells rung thereto, and all the organs piped, and let sound everything that could sound.

**Wittenberg 1525.** The Wittenberg order for the castle church, a year earlier, is far more sparing. The bells are a signal, not festal pomp, and the organ, since it is already there, may sound only at the Sunday *Te Deum* and at German songs. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

> Item campanis utantur ad signum quo significetur quando conveniendum sit ad cantum et quando ad audiendum verbum dei. Non vero utantur illis ad pompam illam festorum. Organis (quando iam illic sunt) possunt, si voluerint, uti solum dominica die ad te deum laudamus et si quando germanica carmina cecinerint.

Item, let them use the bells for a sign, whereby it may be signified when they are to come together to the singing and when to the hearing of the word of God. But let them not use them for that pomp of the feasts. The organs (since they are already there) they may use, if they will, only on the Lord's day at the *Te Deum laudamus*, and whenever they sing German songs.

**The Lutheran norm.** No Lutheran order in the corpus abolishes the organ. Where a church had one, the orders assume an organist and regulate him. Wolfenbüttel 1543 commends him as "honest, and good also for the service of the art of music", and lets the pastor, council and treasury pay him "more or less, according to the worth of his art, for organists are very unequal" (Sehling 6/1, p. 45).

**Strasbourg 1598 against the Reformed.** By the end of the century the organ had to be defended. The Strasbourg order of 1598 opens its chapter "Von dem Gesang und den Orglen" against those who would cast singing and organ out of the church as popish leaven. Sehling's editor notes that the Reformed are meant. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, pp. 602–603):

> Gleich wie wir nit billichen könden noch sollen den vielfältigen Mißbrauch, welcher in dem Bapstumb mit dem Gesang und den Orglen getrieben worden, Also könden wir auch der jenigen Fürnemmen nit loben noch gut heißen, Welche das Gesang und das Orglen als eitel Bäpstischen Saurteig auß der Kirchen allerdings außmustern. […] Was aber die Musicam figuratam und die Orgeln anbelanget, Bringet es die Erfahrung selbst mit, das dadurch der Zuhörenden Hertzen und Gemüte ermuntert und erfrischet werden, Gott, den Herrn, auch mit ihrem Mund unnd Gesang desto frölicher zu loben und zu preisen. Jedoch soll in allweg dahin gesehen werden, Das solche figurata Musica und das Orglen weder das gemeine Gesang der gantzen Kirchen noch den ubrigen Gottesdienst mit Predigen und Betten verhindere und zulang auffhalte.

Even as we cannot nor ought to approve the manifold abuse which was practised in the papacy with singing and organs, so likewise can we not praise nor approve the purpose of those who cast singing and organ-playing wholly out of the church as mere papistical leaven. […] But as touching figural music and the organs, experience itself showeth that thereby the hearts and minds of the hearers are stirred up and refreshed to laud and praise God the Lord the more joyfully with their mouth and singing also. Yet shall it be in every way looked to, that such figural music and organ-playing neither hinder nor too long hold up the common singing of the whole church, nor the rest of the service with preaching and praying.

**The Reformed.** The Reformed orders went the other way. Micron's London order (Reformed) (German edition 1565) rejects "altars, lights, little bells, vestments" (§9.5.4). At Reformed Emden the organ survived in the great church, but it was kept out of the service altogether. **Emden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1594** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 489):

> Des orgels is under dem gesang neen gebruck, ock by dem gadesdenst nicht, ahne allein des Sondages vor negen uhren, wenn sick dat volk samlet, und darna, wenn idt tor kercken wedder utgaet.

Of the organ there is no use during the singing, nor at the service, save only on Sunday before nine o'clock, when the people gather, and afterward, when it goeth out of the church again.

The editor adds that the Reformed synods of Dordrecht (1574, 1578) and Middelburg (1581) pressed for the abolition of organ-playing, and that in some Dutch towns the organ passed to the town council, which had the organist play at set hours to keep people out of the taverns (Sehling 7/1, p. 476, editor's note). The Emden order thus gives exactly the two places that Lutheran orders also gave the organ outside the singing: a prelude while the people gather and a postlude as they leave.

### 9.3.2 The prelude

The orders know two kinds of prelude: a voluntary while the congregation gathers, and the organist's announcement of each piece before it is sung.

**While the people gather.** Strasbourg has the organist begin as soon as the last bell has stopped and "a fair congregation" is there, and play nothing but what the people are about to sing. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 603):

> Darumb, wann man die Musicam figuratam und die Orgel gebrauchen will, Soll es folgender gestalt gehalten werden: Erstlich, das der Organista bei zeit anfange zu ende des letsten leutens, als bald ein zimliche Gemein versamlet ist, Wie dann deßgleichen die Senger in allen andern Predigten auch thun sollen, wann schon nit georglet oder figurirt wird. Zum andern, das er vor und unter dem Gesang der Kirchen nit frembde Stucke und Moteta schlage, Sondern eben das jenig, was hernach die Gemeine singen soll.

Therefore, when one will use figural music and the organ, it shall be held after the following manner. First, that the organist begin betimes, at the end of the last ringing, as soon as a fair congregation is assembled; as likewise the singers shall do at all other sermons, even when there is no organ-playing or figural music. Secondly, that before and during the singing of the church he play no strange pieces and motets, but even that which the congregation shall afterward sing.

The Emden order of 1594 (Reformed; §9.3.1) has the same voluntary "before nine o'clock, when the people gather".

**The organ begins each piece.** In the orders that describe the festal service in detail, the organ begins the hymn or chant and the singers take it up. At Gelnhausen the organist begins the *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, plays the first stanza of the German psalm, and plays "a little piece" after it. The editor glosses "schlage das erst gesetz" as "plays the first stanza". **Gelnhausen, *Kirchenordnung*, [1568]** (Sehling 9, p. 652):

> Nachdem man beydt, sommer und winter, umb sieben uhr das erst zeichen, das ander zu halben achten, und umb achte zusammen geleutet, hebe der organist (weil der furhanden) das veni sancte spiritus an, nachmals singe es der chor aus. Darauff fange der organist einen teutschen psalmen an, schlage das erst gesetz, nachmals singe in der chor aus, one abwechselung der orgel. Nach dem psalmen schlage der organist ein stucklein, darauff folget die collect und lection, darnach fange der organist zuweilen das: Nun bitten wir, zuweilen das: Wir glauben all an einen Got an, der chor singe es gar aus. […] Darauff folget die collect und benediction. Der Organist beschlies mit einem stucklein.

After the first sign hath been rung at seven o'clock, both summer and winter, the second at half past seven, and [all the bells] together at eight, let the organist (if there be one) begin the *Veni Sancte Spiritus*; afterward let the choir sing it out. Thereupon let the organist begin a German psalm, play the first stanza, [and] afterward let the choir sing it out, without alternation of the organ. After the psalm let the organist play a little piece; thereupon followeth the collect and lesson; after that let the organist begin sometimes *Nun bitten wir*, sometimes *Wir glauben all an einen Gott*, [and] let the choir sing it quite out. […] Thereupon followeth the collect and benediction. Let the organist close with a little piece.

Schweinfurt 1576 likewise has "the organist begin to play the Sunday Kyrie, which the choir singeth after", and at the Sunday introit the organist "beginneth to play the introit, which the choir singeth after, as is customary" (Sehling 11, pp. 647–648). At

Hof the organist "always first plays the melody" of each verse of the German *Magnificat* (Sehling 11, p. 429; see Chapter 10, §10.9.4).

**"Präambuliret der organist".** The fullest late example is not a sixteenth-century order. It is a service order sent by the council of Bischofswerda to its cantor in 1676, printed by Sehling in a note. The organist "preambulates" before the Kyrie, after the epistle, after the Gospel and catechism, and before the blessing; at the noon service before the hymn, before the sermon hymn and before the hour of prayer (Sehling 2, p. 106). It shows where the practice of the sixteenth-century orders led, but it is late evidence and is cited here only for comparison.

### 9.3.3 Interludes and alternation

**Alternation.** The commonest use of the organ in the orders is *alternatim*: the organ takes a verse or stanza in turn with the choir or people, and the verse it takes is played, not sung. Regensburg is explicit. Sehling's editor glosses the first sentence "that is, these pieces are not sung", and the communion stanzas "as an interlude". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 421):

> So aber ein organist vorhanden ist, so schlecht er den introit sambt dem Kyrie eleison, Et in terra, Patrem, Sanctus und Agnus Dei auf der orgel, auch sub communione in den teutschen gesengen ein gesetz umb das ander. […] Und woe der organist verhanden, so schlecht er einen vers umb den andern auf der orgel, doch das gleichwol alle vers durchaus ganz gesungen werden umb bessers verstands willen.

But if an organist be present, he playeth the introit together with the *Kyrie eleison*, *Et in terra*, *Patrem*, Sanctus and *Agnus Dei* on the organ, and also under the communion, in the German songs, one stanza after another. […] And where the organist is present, he playeth [at Sunday Vespers] one verse after the other on the organ; yet so that all the verses be nevertheless sung wholly throughout, for the better understanding.

**Three and four choirs.** Naumburg's St Wenzel order sets out the German songs in alternation of schoolboys and people, each with its own cantor. When the organ plays there are three choirs, and when the maidens sing, four. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

> Und solche gesang alle die deuzsch sein, wen das volk versamlet ist, werden ein chor umb den andern gesungen, also der schüler chor ein gesetz singet und anhebt, darnach das volk den andern chor helt, welches auch seinen eigenen cantorem hat. Wan man aber orgel schlegt, werden drei chor gehalten, und hebt die orgel alwegen an, ausgenommen zum et in terra heben die knaben an und darnach die orgel, darauf der chor und dan das volk. Wan aber auch die jungfrauen zu chor singen, so werden vier chor gehalten, und singen die drei chor alle gesetz der deuzschen geseng, einen vers umb den andern, und schlegt der organist ad tonum darein.

And all such songs as are German are sung, when the people is assembled, one choir after the other: the scholars' choir singeth and beginneth a stanza, and after that the people keepeth the other choir, which also hath its own cantor. But when the organ is played, three choirs are kept, and the organ always beginneth, save that at the *Et in terra* the boys begin and after them the organ, thereupon the choir and then the people. But when the maidens also sing in choir, four choirs are kept, and the three choirs sing all the stanzas of the German songs, one verse after the other, and the organist playeth in between in the [same] tone.

The same passage, almost word for word, stands in Caspar Löner's Nördlingen order as revised in 1555 (Sehling 12, p. 320). Hof's three-choir introit with organ, boys, older boys and girls is quoted in Chapter 4, §4.4.5.

**How much the organ might take.** The orders that care most for the congregation's singing limit the organ's share:

- **Strasbourg 1598**: after intoning, the organist may play "not more than once or at the most twice" amid the church's singing (quoted in §9.3.5).
- **Reutlingen 1574**: two stanzas sung, then one played, "about as long as one of the sung stanzas", so that the young and the people learn the hymns. **Reutlingen, *Artikel der Schulvisitation*, 1574** (Sehling 17/2, p. 58):

> zu anndern son- unnd feyertagen aber allwegen zwen vers oder zwey gesetz gesungen unnd darauff eins (das ohngevar so lang alls der gesungnen gesetz eins weren) georglet solle werden, damit der jugent unnd gemeinem volckh die

> christliche kirchen geseng desto bekantter und sie desto eintrechtig unnd gevlißner mitzusingen angereitzt mögen werden.

but on other Sundays and holy days always two verses or two stanzas shall be sung, and thereupon one (which might last about as long as one of the sung stanzas) shall be played on the organ; to the end that the Christian church songs may be the better known to the youth and the common people, and they the more stirred up to sing along with one accord and diligently.

- **Bergedorf 1544**: the organ may play on feast days, but only after the people have sung the whole psalm, and only what has been sung. **Bergedorf, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 5, p. 389):

> Wahr ock orgelen in den kercken weren, die magh men woll an den virdagen gebruken, de psalme unde den vorgemelthen kercksangh darup spelen, doch also, dat dat volk de ganzen psalme thovoren singe, unde up den orgelen allene, wat gesungen is, spele.

Where also there be organs in the churches, one may well use them on the holy days, [and] play the psalms and the aforesaid church song thereon; yet so that the people sing the whole psalms first, and that on the organs only that be played which hath been sung.

- **Schleswig-Holstein 1542**: in the cathedral and collegiate churches the Latin Gloria alternates choir and organ, but the German Gloria, the German hymn in place of the sequence and the German Creed are sung by "the whole church" straight through "without organ". **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 146):

> Averst des Sondages edder yn den Festen, Wann de Prester gesungen hefft: Gloria yn Excelsis Deo, Darup de Chor unde nicht de örgeln Antwerden: Et yn terra Pax Hominibus Bona voluntas, so schal men gar unde gantz uphören, Darmit de gantze Kercke hernamals singen möge: Allene Godt yn der höge sy eer etc., Welcker gesanck ane underlath beth thom ende schal gesungen werden ane Orgelent. Darna so vart dat Chor unde orgelen vort tho singende: Laudamus te, Benedicimus te etc., beth thom ende, Darna Alleluia. Averst yn stede der Sequentien schal wedderumme singen de gantze Kercke einen düdeschen sanck ane underlath unde ock ane örgelen.

But on Sunday or on the feasts, when the priest hath sung *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, and the choir and not the organ hath answered *Et in terra pax hominibus bonae voluntatis*, then shall they stop altogether, that the whole church may afterward sing *Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr*, etc., which song shall be sung without break to the end, without organ-playing. After that the choir and organ go on to sing *Laudamus te*, *Benedicimus te*, etc., to the end; after that the Alleluia. But in the stead of the sequence the whole church shall again sing a German song without break and also without organ.

**Organ and the people's hymn at communion.** Pomerania's *Agenda* lets the organ play during the communion hymns, but only three times: once at the beginning, once in the middle and once at the end. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 439):

> Wenn dise gesenge under der communion gesungen werden, schölen de organisten eren gesank mit der orgel deste körter maken, unde nene weltlike, lichtverdige gesenge slan. De pastor schal vorschaffen, dat de orgeln der maten modereret werden, dat men de düdischen psalme under der communion mit der gemeine ganz tom ende singe, unde dat de vörgesetteden gesenge ummeschichtich gesungen werden, dat dat chor unde dat volk einen vers umme den andern singe, up dat se alle to gelick den schölern unde der gemeine gebrücklick werden, derwegen kan de organiste ein mal tom anfange, ein mal im middel, na gelegenheit, einmal tom ende, vor der collecta, orgelen.

When these songs are sung under the communion, the organists shall make their song on the organ the shorter, and play no worldly, light songs. The pastor shall provide that the organs be so moderated that the German psalms under the communion be sung with the congregation wholly to the end, and that the aforesaid songs be sung in turn, the choir and the people singing one verse after the other, so that they all be alike in use by the scholars and the congregation. Therefore the organist may play once at the beginning, once in the middle as occasion serveth, [and] once at the end, before the collect.

**Hamburg 1556** lets the organist play "fittingly in between" the verses of the German psalm sung in place of the alleluia and sequence, "as elsewhere is customary, or, as the time allows, close the song with the organ" (Sehling 5, p. 552). Stettin forbids its organists to "fantasize on the organ while other good Christians sing the psalms with the congregation" (§9.3.7).

#### 9.3.4 Organ pieces between the parts of the service

Beside the alternation, some orders give the organ a short piece of its own between the parts of the service. The fullest list is Schönburg's. **Schönburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, pp. 170–171):

> Vor dem introitu kyrie eleison, soll der chor ein kyrie, ein christe und wiederum ein kyrie singen und der organista dazu schlagen. An oder für das letzte mag er auch ein gut kurz stücklein schlagen etc. […] 3. Nach der epistel schlägt der organist, darauf singt der chor das alleluja, zuweilen den sequenz, so fern der rein und christlich ist, darauf die ganze ecclesia einen teutschen psalmen oder christlich lied, was man will, wie im gesang-büchlein zu finden. 4. Nach dem evangelisten, dem patrem etc. lateinisch schlägt der organist, singet die kirche: Wir glauben etc. 5. Nach der predigt schlägt der organista etwas, bis der priester über den altar kommt, praeparavitque panem et calicem offerendum. […] 7. […] Der organista soll sub communione nicht schlagen, es sei denn an hohen festen; aber nach gehaltener communion mag er ein gut stücke schlagen.

Before the introit, [at the] *Kyrie eleison*, the choir shall sing one Kyrie, one Christe and again one Kyrie, and the organist play thereto. At or before the last he may also play a good short little piece, etc. […] 3. After the epistle the organist playeth; thereupon the choir singeth the alleluia, sometimes the sequence, so far as it is pure and Christian; thereupon the whole church [singeth] a German psalm or Christian song, whichever one will, as is found in the song-book. 4. After the Gospel [and] the *Patrem*, etc., in Latin, the organist playeth; the church singeth *Wir glauben*, etc. 5. After the sermon the organist playeth something, until the priest come to the altar and have prepared the bread and the cup to be offered. […] 7. […] The organist shall not play under the communion, except on high feasts; but after the communion is held he may play a good piece.

**Schweinfurt 1576** puts an organ piece in the place of the *Et in terra*: "upon the Gloria, etc., and instead of the *Et in terra*, etc., the organist playeth some music" (Sehling 11, p. 647). Gelnhausen's "little piece" after the psalm (§9.3.2) is of the same kind.

#### 9.3.5 The postlude

**After the blessing.** Strasbourg keeps the organist's freer music, and Latin motets, for the end of the service, when those who want to listen may stay and the rest may go about their business. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 603):

> Damit sich auch das Orgeln und Singen nit zu lang verziehe, Soll er, nach dem er intonirt, nit uber ein- oder zum höchsten zweimal unter das Gesang der Kirchen schlagen, Sondern derselben ihre zeit lassen, ihr Gesang mit gemeiner Stimme und Andacht zuverrichten. Wenn aber der Gottesdienst allerding verrichtet und dem Volck der Segen gegeben ist, Als dann mag der Organist auch andere Stucke schlagen oder auch Lateinische Moteta singen lassen, Dabei dann jederzeit ohn zweivel die jenige gern bleiben werden, die Lust und Anmut dazu haben. Und wird doch das gemeine Volck, welches lieber seinen Geschüften nachgeht, dadurch nit verhindert noch aufgehalten. Wann auch die Gesänge, welche das Volck singet, getheilet werden, das entweder der Organist dazwischen schlägt oder ein theil des Gesangs biß nach der Predigt gesparet wird, Welches letstere doch allein bei den längeren Gesängen geschehen soll, Soll man die Gesänge also theilen, das, was dem Verstand und innhalt nach zusammen gehöret, bei einandern bleibe und nit von einandern gerissen werde.

And that the organ-playing and singing be not drawn out too long, he shall, after he hath intoned, play not more than once, or at the most twice, amid the singing of the church, but leave it its time to perform its singing with common voice and devotion. But when the service is wholly performed and the blessing given to the people, then may the organist play other pieces also, or have Latin motets sung; whereat those will without doubt always gladly stay who have pleasure and liking thereto; and yet the common people, which would rather go after its business, is not thereby hindered nor held up. When also the songs which the people singeth are divided, so that either the organist playeth between, or a part of the song is kept until after the sermon (which latter yet shall be done only with the longer songs), one shall so divide the songs that what belongeth together in sense and content remain together and be not torn from one another.

**Other postludes.**

- **Gelnhausen [1568]**: "Let the organist close with a little piece" (§9.3.2).
- **Schönburg 1542**: "after the communion is held he may play a good piece" (§9.3.4).
- **Emden 1594** (Reformed): the organ only "when it goeth out of the church again" (§9.3.1).
- **Prussia 1568**: at Vespers the organist plays alternate verses of the *Magnificat*, and "after the *Nunc dimittis*" plays a piece. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

> Wo man einen organisten hat, schlecht er einen vers um den andern, das nach dem magnificat der chor die deutsch antiphonam singet und der organist nach dem nunc dimittis ein stück schleget. Darauf schleusst man mit dem versikel, collekten und benedicamus domino.

Where there is an organist, he playeth one verse after the other, so that after the *Magnificat* the choir singeth the German antiphon, and the organist after the *Nunc dimittis* playeth a piece. Thereupon they close with the versicle, collects and *Benedicamus Domino*.

- **Hamburg 1556**: the organists are to play "before and after the sermon" on holy days and working days, and at Vespers on all holy eves and days. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 547):

> Dat organisten, erer kunst wol erfaren, unde ehrlike menner angenamen werden, düsse schollen beide hillige dage unde werkeldage in den kerken, dar to acht schlägen geprediget wert, vor unde nah der predige, ock to der vesper in allen hilligen avenden unde dagen na des chores ordinarii meldinge up der orgelen spelen. De organisten schollen sick mit denen im chore des gesanges vergeliken, und eindrechtichlick, dat se im chore anfangen, up den orgelen spelen. De organisten schollen sick entholden, werltlike, schimplike unde untüchtige lede in den karken to spelende.

That organists well skilled in their art and honest men be taken on. These shall play on the organs, both on holy days and working days, in the churches where there is preaching at eight o'clock, before and after the sermon, also at Vespers on all holy eves and days, according to the direction of the choir's *ordinarius*. The organists shall agree with those in the choir about the singing, and play on the organs in accord with what they begin in the choir. The organists shall refrain from playing worldly, scurrilous and unseemly songs in the churches.

#### 9.3.6 When the organ was silent

**Seasons.**

- **Lent and Passiontide.** Hamburg 1529 lets the organ "rest for a time, especially the fortnight over, when the Passion is preached" (Sehling 5, p. 513). Nördlingen 1555 lets the organ "remain out" in Lent until Easter, except on the Annunciation (Sehling 12, p. 320).
- **Advent.** Hof suspends the organ from the second Sunday of Advent to Christmas Eve. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 432):

> Nota. Hac dominica suspenduntur organa usque ad vigiliam Nativitatis Christi.

Note. On this Sunday the organs are suspended until the vigil of the Nativity of Christ.

- **Rogation week.** Pomerania 1569 has "no figural song nor organ" in Rogation week, except on the Ascension and its vigil (Sehling 4, p. 466; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.5).
- **Lower feasts.** Henneberg 1582 keeps the lower feasts "without organ", and Aschersleben 1575 sings the Vespers of apostles' days "without the organist" (cited in Chapter 12, §12.10.5).

**Rites.**

- **The litany.** On the Henneberg prayer day of 1582 the German litany is sung "without organ or figural music" (Sehling 2, p. 311).
- **The communion.** Wolfenbüttel forbids the organ after the sermon in the Mass, so that the Supper may be attended to "in remembrance of Christ". **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 45):

> Süst mach de organiste alle Sundage na willen des pastoris spelen. Overst in der misse schal men yd nicht lange maken, dat de predike nicht werde vorhindert und dat de leyen dar ock ruhm hebben, Christum mit düdeschem gesange to lavende. Doch na der predike in der misse schal men nicht up den orgelen spelen, sondern alleine des aventmals Christi dar wahrnemen tho Christi gedechtnisse.

Otherwise the organist may play every Sunday at the pastor's will. But in the Mass one shall not make it long, that the sermon be not hindered, and that the laity also have room there to praise Christ with German song. Yet after the sermon in the Mass one shall not play on the organs, but attend only to the Supper of Christ there, in remembrance of Christ.

Schönburg 1542 likewise keeps the organ silent under the communion except on high feasts (§9.3.4), and Reutlingen 1574 drops the organ "wholly" on communion days because the service is then longer (Sehling 17/2, p. 58).

- **Baptism.** At Thorn baptism is to be held when the church is quiet, not under the singing or the organ. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560–1570** (Sehling 4, p. 230):

> Die taufe soll gehalten werden, wen es in der kirchen stille ist, nicht unterm gesang oder orgeln, mit aller andacht und ererbietung, und nicht mit unnützen geschwetz der beistehenden

Baptism shall be held when it is still in the church, not under the singing or organ-playing, with all devotion and reverence, and not with the idle chatter of the bystanders

**At weddings, by private arrangement.** Hamburg 1529 allows the organ and the scholars' *Te Deum*, or figural music, at a wedding, "as the people have arranged it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money" (§9.4.4).

#### 9.3.7 The organist: what he might not play

The orders do not prescribe repertory beyond the hymns and chants. They forbid the secular:

- **Calenberg-Göttingen 1542**: organists are to set the spiritual songs themselves or obtain settings, "for love-songs and worldly songs are not at all fitting to be played in the congregation". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 785):

> Desgleichen sollen auch vleis thun die organisten, das sie die geistlichen lieder entweder selbs absetzen oder von anderen abgesetzt uberkomen. Denn bulen und weltliche lieder wollen sich in der gemeine zu schlagen gar nicht gebüren aus ursachen, das nach der lere Pauli 1. Corint. am 14. alles zur besserung daselbs geschehen sol.

Likewise the organists also shall take diligence that they either set the spiritual songs themselves or obtain them set by others. For love-songs and worldly songs are not at all fitting to be played in the congregation, for this cause, that after the teaching of Paul, 1 Corinthians 14, all things there should be done unto edifying.

- **Hamburg 1556**: no "worldly, scurrilous and unseemly songs" (§9.3.5).
- **Pomerania 1569**: "no worldly, light songs" (§9.3.3).
- **Stettin 1573**: the visitation's articles for the organists. **Stettin, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1573** (Sehling 4, p. 533):

> III. Weil auch unraht und schade daraus erfolget, wen fremde ohne unterscheid auf die orgel kommen, sollen sie niemand ohne vorwissen des pastoris darauf lassen […]. V. Zu rechter zeit dieselbigen stimmen und einrichten, nicht wen man beicht höret oder albereit hat angefangen zu singen. VI. Sie sollen auch nicht weltliche lieder oder tentze auf der orgel schlagen. […] IX. Mit den cantoribus sollen sie auch einmütig sein, nicht oftmals inen zu vordruss zu hoch stimmen oder sonst mit unterheulen oder wen andere gute christen die psalmen mitsingen in der gemeine auf den orgeln fantasiren. X. Die leute nicht ubersetzen in den hochzeiten, wan sie gefordert werden, das sie in den kirchen aufwarten, sondern nehmen, was verordnet ist. XI. Sie sollen sich nicht ausgeben vor gemeine spielleute, daraus vorachtung des ministerii folgt. XII. Das sie auch das ministerium in allen ehren halten und nicht von der orgel alsbald aus der kirchen laufen und gottes wort verachten und verseumen.

III. Since also mischief and harm follow when strangers come upon the organ without distinction, they shall let no one upon it without the pastor's knowledge […]. V. [They shall] tune and set the same at the right time, not when confession is being heard or the singing hath already begun. VI. They shall also play no worldly songs or dances on the organ. […] IX. They shall also be of one mind with the cantors, not often, to their vexation, pitch too high, or otherwise howl underneath, or fantasize on the organs when other good Christians are singing the psalms with the congregation. X. [They shall] not overcharge the people at weddings, when they are required to attend in the churches, but take what is appointed. XI. They shall not pass themselves off as common minstrels, from which contempt of the ministry followeth. XII. That they also hold the ministry in all honour, and do not run straight from the organ out of the church and despise and neglect God's word.

- **Emden 1577** (Reformed): the town's organist, who was also the town piper, is forbidden "all galliards and other light dances" (§9.4.2).

**Cantor, organist and pastor.** The organist is subject to the pastor (Hamburg 1556, Stettin 1573) and is to agree with the choir about what is sung (Hamburg 1556). His appointment by contract is treated in Chapter 13, §13.12.3 (Hildesheim 1581).

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## 9.4 Other instruments

**In brief.** Apart from the organ, the church orders mention instruments in church only rarely, and then for figural music on feasts, at a court, or at weddings. The instruments named are trombones (*Posaunen*, *basunen*), the town pipers' wind instruments (*Pfeifer*), fiddles (*Fidler*), and, outside the service, the carillon, the cornett and trombone of the tower-blower, and the drums, trumpets, pipes and strings of the wedding minstrels. No order in the corpus names a regal, a lute, a cornett or a trumpet in the service itself, and none names a "Sanctus trumpet" or any instrumental signal at the altar other than a bell.

### 9.4.1 Trombones at the Ansbach court, 1538

Margrave George's mandate of 1538 in defence of figural and choral singing tells the clergy that at his residence at Ansbach the psalms and other scriptural songs are not only sung but accompanied with trombones and other instruments, as is also done at weddings in church. **Ansbach, *Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen*, 1538** (Sehling 11, p. 397):

> So lassen wir auch soliche geseng als nemblich psalmen und ander ding, aus heiliger gotlichen schrift gezogen, und nit weltliche, zu unzucht raizende liedle, hie zu Onoltzbach als in unserm furstlichen anwesen (zu geburlicher zeit) nit allain singen, sonder denselben gesengen mit pusaunen und andern dergleichen instrumenten beistand tun - nit zu unserm oder der unsern wollust, sonder zuvorderst, ja auch allein zu der ehre Gottes des Almächtigen, dahin auch solichs wie sonst alles anders entlich gerichtet und gemeint sein sölle -, wie auch hie zu allen hochzeiten in der kirchen nit unzimblich geschicht und gehalten wurdet.

So also do we cause such songs, namely psalms and other things drawn out of the holy divine Scripture, and not worldly ditties that provoke to lewdness, here at Onolzbach, as at our princely residence (at fitting time), not only to be sung, but also have these songs assisted with trombones and other such instruments (not for the pleasure of us or ours, but first of all, yea, solely to the honour of God Almighty, whereto this, like all else, shall in the end be directed and meant), as is also not unseemly done and observed here at all weddings in the church.

### 9.4.2 Emden (Reformed): the organist as town piper, the carillon and the tower

In 1577 the council of Emden engaged Paul Hanssen, already the town piper, as organist of the great church for a year. His contract binds him to the organ, to "Christian music and other instruments" on feast days, to the carillon, and to blowing from the town-hall tower with a journeyman and a pupil. **Emden, *Organistenvertrag*, 1577** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 475–478):

> 3. Tom drudden soll he idt orgel mit flyte und guider voirsorge bedienen, und up den festdagen mit christlicher musica und anderen darin stemmenden instrumenten, sovele eme moeglich, bedienen. […] 4. Item idt klockenspil, alse syther beschehen, up gewonlichen tyden versorgen. […] 6. Und dewile he nu dit jair beide dienste togelycke werd bedenen, soll he up seinen kosten einen guiden gesellen beneffens sick tor stadt dienst holden, die mit eme und einen seiner discipulen, dairto bequem, alle weke twiemal van den raithuißtorn […] 8. Item alle galiarden und sunst lichtferdige danse soll he in gene wegen spelen, vele weiniger danzscholen holden.

3. Thirdly, he shall serve the organ with diligence and good care, and on the feast days serve with Christian music and other instruments according therewith, so far as he may. […] 4. Item, [he shall] tend the carillon at the customary times, as hath been done hitherto. […] 6. And whereas he will now this year serve both offices together, he shall at his own cost keep a good journeyman beside him for the town's service, who with him and one of his pupils fit thereto [shall] twice every week [blow] from the town-hall tower […] 8. Item, he shall in no wise play any galliards or other light dances, much less keep dancing-schools.

The sixth article goes on to have the tower-blowing done also "through the whole eight days" of the annual fairs. Sehling's editor adds from the church accounts that in 1579 Paul's brother Janken was paid "for that he adorned the church with trombone-blowing in the organ", that boys sang at the high feasts "in the organ" in 1584 and 1587, and that a tower-watchman engaged in 1679 had to blow "a psalm with cornett and trombone" at eleven and at sunset, and a verse of a psalm or hymn every hour of the night (Sehling 7/1, pp. 476–477, editor's notes). The last is a seventeenth-century witness, and the instruments in the organ were added to a Reformed service whose order of 1594 kept the organ out of the singing (§9.3.1).

#### 9.4.3 Danzig: town pipers and fiddlers in the choir, 1612

The Danzig order of 1612 is the one order in the corpus that puts instrumentalists on the church's payroll for the service. Beside the choir-men and assistants, the town pipers (three masters and three journeymen) and three fiddlers are retained "for the choir", and must come "with their instruments" whenever there is figural music, and obey the *Kapellmeister*. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, p. 212):

> Noch werden nebenst diesen chorgesellen und astanten der stadt pfeifer, nemlich drei meister und drei gesellen zu chor gehalten […]. Item, nebenst diesen pfeifern sein auch zu chor bestellet drei fidler; den gibt man semptlich alle quartal 9 M, thut das ganze jahr 36 M. Dess haben diese beiderlei spielleute auch zu geniessen, das sie auf hochzeiten für andere gefördert werden, und müssen ihnen keine frembde spielleute eingriff thun. […] Für diss salarium und accidentien seind beide, die pfeifer und fidler schuldig, allezeit, wen man figuriren soll, nebenst dem chorgesellen und astanten mit ihren instrumenten sich fruhzeitig einzustellen und auch nebenst ihnen den capellmeister in allen, wie es mit der musica verordnet, zugehorchen, und wer hierinnen nachlessig gefunden würde, soll nach erkenntnüss der kirchenväter gestrafet werden. Imgleichen sein sie auch zu brautmessen zeit aufzuwarten schuldig, sintemal sie von den breutigam ihre besoldunge dafür empfangen.

Further, beside these choir-men and assistants, the town pipers, namely three masters and three journeymen, are kept for the choir […]. Item, beside these pipers there are also engaged for the choir three fiddlers; to them together is given every quarter 9 marks, which maketh for the whole year 36 marks. Both these kinds of minstrels have also this benefit, that they are preferred before others at weddings, and no strange minstrels may encroach upon them. […] For this salary and these perquisites both the pipers and the fiddlers are bound, whenever there is to be figural music, to present themselves betimes with their instruments beside the choir-men and assistants, and with them to obey the *Kapellmeister* in all things, as is ordained for the music; and whoever is found negligent herein shall be punished at the discretion of the churchwardens. Likewise they are bound to attend at the time of nuptial Masses, since they receive their pay for it from the bridegroom.

The lutenists named in Danzig's ordinances on wedding feasts belong to the feast, not to the church (Sehling 4, p. 197).

#### 9.4.4 Weddings: minstrels to the churchyard gate

The minstrels of a wedding procession played the bridal party to church. The orders let them play up to the churchyard and keep them out of the service.

**Hamburg 1529.** The minstrels play before the bride and bridegroom as far as the churchyard; in church there may be organ and singing by private arrangement. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 516):

> also dat vormiddage de brudegam mit den mans voran und dar na de brudt mit orer selschup na der karcken gaen, und de spellude spelen vor en her bet an den kerckhof. Dar machme denne in der karcken up den orgelen spelen und singen mit den scholeren Te deum laudamus, edder wat anders van gade, edder ock in figurativis etc., wo de lude idt denne mit dem organisten und cantoren vor ohre drankgelt hebben bestellet. Dar truwet me se denne vor dem hogen altar, wo wontlick

so that in the forenoon the bridegroom with the men go before, and after them the bride with her company, to the church, and the minstrels play before them as far as the churchyard. There one may then in the church play on the organs and sing with the scholars *Te Deum laudamus*, or something else of God, or also in figural music, etc., as the people have then arranged it with the organist and cantor for their drink-money. There they are then wedded before the high altar, as is customary

**Not during the sermon.** Nassau-Dillenburg bids the wedding party come to church in time, so that the preacher is not disturbed by their music. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 112):

> Es sollen sich auch breutgam unnd braut sampt iren freundtschafften unnd geladenen gesten zur bestimptten predigstunde zeitlich zur kirchen finden, damit der prediger, so er die predig schon angefangen hette, durch das pfeiffen, geigen unnd ander hochzeitlich spiel nicht geirret und andere unruig gemacht werden

The bridegroom and bride also, together with their kinsfolk and invited guests, shall be found at church in good time at the appointed hour of preaching, that the preacher, if he had already begun the sermon, be not put out, nor others made unquiet, by the piping, fiddling and other wedding music

**Herford 1532** asks the council to keep everything silent near the church while the sermon is preached: bells, drums, trumpets and pipes. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 171):

> Id is ock van noden und themlick, dat se sick entholden und stille sin under dem prediken, Alle klocken, id sy den doden offt nicht, Item bungen und trometen, pipen und solckes, dat up dem kerckhove offt sus na by der kerken de predikers offt thohorers vorstoren mochte

It is also needful and seemly that they refrain and be still during the preaching: all bells, be it for the dead or not; item drums and trumpets, pipes and such things as might disturb the preachers or hearers on the churchyard, or otherwise near by the church

**A sign of honour withheld.** At Schwäbisch Hall a couple who had not waited for their wedding went to church without music. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

> Braut und Bräutigam, die Ihrer Ehren nit erwartet, sondern darwider gehandelt, und diß außfindig worden, sollen ohne Saitenspiel und die Braut mit bedecktem Haupt zur Kirchen gehen.

Bride and bridegroom who have not waited for their honour, but have acted against it, and this hath been found out, shall go to church without string-music, and the bride with covered head.

**Trumpets and kettledrums at the feast.** The trumpets and drums named in the orders belong to the wedding procession and feast, and the sumptuary orders regulate or forbid them:

- **Bremen 1546**: all estates may use the council's minstrels, "the first two with the trumpets and the other two with pipes and drums" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 496).
- **Danzig 1590/1595**: the wedding ordinances forbid trumpets, the military fanfare (*Feldgeschrei*) and kettledrums at weddings, as "no burgher's merriment" (Sehling 4, p. 195).
- **Nordstrand 1605**: trumpets are wholly forbidden at weddings, christening feasts and other feasts (Sehling 23, p. 411).
- **Ulm 1531** (Moderate Reformed): according to the editor, the council's decree of 18 June 1531 on baptisms and weddings asked that weddings be blessed without any display, including music with drums, wind and string instruments (Sehling 17/2, p. 68, editor's introduction).

**The organist as minstrel.** Stettin 1573 forbids its organists to overcharge for playing at weddings, or to "pass themselves off as common minstrels" (§9.3.7). Ansbach 1538 (§9.4.1) and Danzig 1612 (§9.4.3) show instruments at weddings in church; Hof 1592 has figural music "before and after" the wedding (Sehling 11, p. 430).

#### 9.4.5 Drums on the tower at Zwickau

The visitors at Zwickau stopped the drumming and carousing on the tower of St Mary's, like the fencing-school, during the Sunday afternoon sermon. **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 723):

> Das pauken und queserei auf dem kirchenthurm zu unser liben frauen, desgleichen die fechtschul, soll under des nachmittags predigt des sontags und anderer feste absein und nicht gehalten werden bis noch vorendung derselben predigt.

The drumming and carousing on the church tower of Our Dear Lady, likewise the fencing-school, shall cease during the afternoon sermon of the Sunday and other feasts, and not be held until after the end of the same sermon.

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## 9.5 Bells

#### 9.5.1 What the bells are for

**A signal to the Word and to prayer.** The orders agree that bells exist to call people to the preaching of the Word and to common prayer. Wittenberg 1525 (§9.3.1) allows them "for a sign … when they are to come together to the singing and when to the hearing of the word of God", and not "for that pomp of the feasts". Saxe-Lauenburg sets out the same principle, then forbids weather-ringing and secular use of the bells. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 423):

> Und weil die glocken umb des gottesdienstes willen fürnemlich vorordnet worden, dass die leute damit zum gehör göttliches wortes und gemeinem gebete gefodert werden, und aber im bapstthumb greulicher missbrauch und aberglauben mit den glocken getrieben ist worden, als die schreckliche donnerwetter damit von einander zu treiben, so sol solches gottloses wesend hiemit genzlichen abgeschaffet, und bei peen und harter ungnade vorboten sein, und sollen auch die glocken zu keinem weltlichen gebrauch und sachen gerüret, noch gezogen werden, es geschehe denn, dass wegen des feindes oder feursnot, oder wenn die fronendienste den leuten angekündiget sollen werden, oder sonsten in nothwendigen gemeinen sachen das volk zusammen müste geleutet werden. Und sol solch leuten alles von niemand, denn von dem cüster geschehen, weil ihm die glocken amptes halben befohlen sein.

And since the bells were ordained chiefly for the sake of divine service, that the people be summoned by them to the hearing of God's word and to common prayer, and yet in the papacy horrible abuse and superstition have been practised with the bells, as to drive asunder the terrible thunderstorms with them, such godless doing shall hereby be wholly abolished, and forbidden on pain of penalty and heavy displeasure. And the bells shall not be touched nor pulled for any worldly use or matter, unless it be that the people must be rung together because of the enemy or of fire, or when the labour-services are to be announced to the people, or otherwise in necessary common affairs. And all such ringing shall be done by none but the sexton, since the bells are committed to him by virtue of his office.

**Against pomp.** Some orders cut back the festal ringing and chiming as a relic of the old feasts:

- **Danzig 1567**: "the ringing and chiming on the feasts and their vigils, which are not appointed and have no ground in God's word", is to be left off by the ringers, "to avoid papistical suspicion" (Sehling 4, p. 187).
- **Bentheim 1601** (Reformed): the count renews his mandate against "the unnecessary, manifold ringing, and especially the superstitious chiming with the bells", on Sundays and feasts as at funerals. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Mandat zum Glockenläuten*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 302):

> daß sie sich hinfürter deß beyerenß mit den glocken durchauß enthalten unnd auff den son-, auch den festagenn zu den predigten dreimahl vorher nacheinander nur mitt einer glockenn unnd, wan daß beschehen, zu ende uffs letzste mit einem [kl]einem glöckschen, sofern ein solchß verhandenn, leuten, auch zu begrebnuß der thodtenn bei der maß, so in ihrer g. kirchenordnung außtrücklich angedeütet, verbleiben, unnd sich deß anderen ubermessigen täglichen leütenß keineßwegß hinfürter zubrauchen eüsseren sollen

that they [the sextons] shall henceforth wholly refrain from chiming with the bells, and on Sundays and also on feast days ring to the sermons three times beforehand, one after the other, with one bell only, and, when that is done, at the end, last of all, with a little bell, if there be one; and at the burial of the dead keep to the measure expressly set out in his Grace's church order; and shall in no wise henceforth make use of the other excessive daily ringing

**Rank by bells.** Most Lutheran orders, though, kept the festal ringing as a mark of the day. At the Altenburg castle chapter in 1533, working days are rung in with one great bell, and Sundays and feasts "with more bells, to distinguish the time" (Sehling 1, p. 516; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.7). Danzig 1612 chimes the great feasts with the three larger bells and the small feasts "with the Osanna" (ibid.).

### 9.5.2 The summons to church

**Three signs.** The usual summons is three spells of ringing, often with different bells, the last of them "together" (*zusammen*) with all the bells:

- **Gelnhausen [1568]**: the first sign at seven, the second at half past seven, and all together at eight (§9.3.2).
- **Bentheim 1601** (Reformed): three times with one bell, then a little bell last (§9.5.1).
- **Esslingen 1540** (Moderate Reformed): a forewarning with the bell used on working days for singing, then a second, short sign with the noon bell, after which the sermon begins at once. **Esslingen, *Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst*, 1540** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 394):

> das man hinfüro uff die sonntäg zu den dreyen predigen vor unnd nach mittags allwegen ain vorzaichen mit der singglocken, so man an wercktagen pflegt zu prauchen, ain gutte weil leutten und folgents, so man die predigen schier anfahen will, das annder zaichen mit der mittag glockenn unnd dasselbig ganntz kurtz leutten soll. Allso wann dasselbig ander zaichen mit der bemellten mittag glokken außgeleuttet, das alls balld die predigen angefangen werde.

that henceforth on Sundays, to the three sermons before and after noon, one shall always ring a fore-sign with the singing bell, which is wont to be used on working days, a good while; and afterward, when the sermons are about to begin, the second sign with the noon bell, and that quite short. So that when the same second sign with the said noon bell hath been rung out, the sermons be begun straightway.

**Restored where it had been dropped.** At Allstedt the visitors of 1533 restored the ringing to the sermon "where Thomas Müntzer abolished it" (Sehling 1, p. 511; quoted in §9.5.3).

**Kept plain.** Heilbronn's sexton was told around 1529 to ring only "for the early-Mass sermon and child baptism, but never more for the office of the Mass and Vespers" (Sehling 17/1, p. 226, editor's introduction; §9.5.7). Zwickau 1529 keeps the ringing to sermon, Mass and Vespers, but "to Vespers and for the dead, also early to the lesson", with one bell only (§9.5.6).

**The sexton and the clock.** Ringing was the sexton's office. Hamburg 1529 bids the sextons "take care that all the bells strike evenly and rightly" (Sehling 5, p. 512). Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 asks the pastors to get village churches a striking clock, or at least a sundial, "or that the sexton at least have a compass, whereby he may know how to order himself with the ringing and other things at the due time" (Sehling 5, p. 423).

**The Danzig bells, 1612.** The fullest description of a ring of bells and its use is the Danzig order of 1612 for St Mary's. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, pp. 202–203):

> Art. 12. Wieviel glocken auf den kirchenthurm sein, und wie sie heissen, item, wie sie gebraucht werden. Die erste und grosseste glocke wird Ave Maria genant von alters, darumb das es die beteglocke ist. Sie wird auch Sigismundus und itziger zeit gemeiniglich die grosse glocke genant, wird von 12 mann gezogen. Die andere wird Osanna genant, auch die sturmglocke, und wird von fünf mann gezogen. Die dritte heisst Apostolica, darumb das auf die aposteltage damit gebeigert wird, wie hernach folget, und wird von fünf mann gezogen. Die vierte heisset Dominicalis, darumb das sie alle sonntage gebrauchet wird, von vier mann gezogen. Die fünfte wird Ferialis genandt, darumb das sie alle tage gebrauchet wird, von zwei mann gezogen. Die sechste heisst Sybilla oder Campana Cymbala, darumb das man alle zeit, wenn es von nöten damit signiert, und wird von einem manne gedeutet. Die siebende henget über diesen glocken allen und wird lange glocke genannt, darumb das sie zu gewisser zeit, entweder eine ganze stunde, oder zum kürzesten eine halbe stunde lang geleutet wird. Auch nennt man sie landglocke. Darumb das man sie umb die stadt herumb weit auf dem lande hören kan, dieselbe wird von einem mann gezogen. […] Am sonntage des morgens, wen der seger viere schleget, wird mit der Dominical ein puls von einem schock zügen oder ein wenig länger geleutet, und bald darauf die lange glocke, bis es fünfe schlaget, balde hernach wen es fünfe geschlagen, mit der Dominical und Ferial zusammen von zwei schock zügen, darnach wen es sechs geschlagen, wird mit der Osanna ein puls von zwei schock zügen zur morgen predigt, und den auf segers halb zwölf zu mittage mit der Osanna zur mittags predigt.

Art. 12. How many bells there are on the church tower, and what they are called; item, how they are used. The first and greatest bell is called of old Ave Maria, because it is the prayer bell. It is also called Sigismund, and nowadays commonly the great bell; it is pulled by twelve men. The second is called Osanna, also the storm bell, and is pulled by five men. The third is called Apostolica, because it is chimed on the apostles' days, as followeth hereafter, and is pulled by five men. The fourth is called Dominicalis, because it is used every Sunday; [it is] pulled by four men. The fifth is called Ferialis, because it is used every day; [it is] pulled by two men. The sixth is called Sybilla or *Campana Cymbala*, because one signals with it at all times when it is needful, and it is sounded by one man. The seventh hangeth above all these bells and is called the long bell, because at a set time it is rung either a whole hour or at the shortest a half hour long. It is also called the land bell, because one can hear it far out in the country round about the city; the same is pulled by one man. […] On Sunday in the morning, when the clock striketh four, a pulse of three-score pulls or a little longer is rung with the Dominical, and soon after the long bell, until it strike five; soon after, when it hath struck five, with the Dominical and Ferial together, of two score-and-sixty pulls [twice three-score]; after that, when it hath struck six, a pulse of twice three-score pulls is rung with the Osanna to the morning sermon; and then at half past eleven by the clock, at midday, with the Osanna to the midday sermon.

The article goes on to the afternoon, the working days, funerals (signalled with the Sybilla, then rung with the bells the family has paid for), the apostles' days, and the high and low feasts.

### 9.5.3 The daily bells: morning, noon and evening, and the prayer for peace

**Kept for prayer.** The morning and evening bell of the medieval *Angelus* (the "Ave Maria") and the evening *Salve* bell were nearly everywhere kept, but given a new meaning: a call to pray for peace (*pro pace*), for the government and against the Turk, and a time-signal for workers. The Prussian order of 1544 keeps the daily ringing in villages even where there is no Matins or Vespers. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 67):

> Es ist nicht ein böser gebrauch, das man in dörfern und kleinen flecken nach alter gewonheit zu morgen und abends teglich leutet, ob man gleich da selbst weder metten noch vesper helt, sondern zur erinnerung dem volk, damit ein eusserlichs denkzeichen zum gebet gibt, es sei in heusern ader aufem felde, umb gemeinen frieden und allerlei wolfart zu bitten und zur danksagung für alle wolthat des herren gottes, darumb ist es für gut angesehen, das es auch also hinfurt teglich gehalten werde.

It is not an evil custom that in villages and small market towns one ringeth daily, after old custom, at morning and evening, although one holdeth there neither Matins nor Vespers, but for a reminder to the people, whereby an outward token is given to prayer, be it in the houses or in the field, to pray for the common peace and all manner of welfare, and for thanksgiving for all the benefits of the Lord God. Therefore it is thought good that it be kept daily so henceforth.

**Saxony 1528.** The Saxon visitors tell pastors not to quarrel with their people over the *pacem* ringing, but to teach them its right use. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 170):

> Viel pfarherr zanken sich auch mit den pfarrleuten umb unnötige und kindische sachen, als vom pacem leuten, und der gleichen. An solchen sachen sollen billich die pfarherr, als die vernunftigen, umb friedens willen, den leuten weichen, und sie unterrichten, wo solchs leuten unrecht gebraucht, das es nu fort wol gebraucht würde

Many pastors also quarrel with their parishioners about needless and childish matters, as about the ringing of the *pacem* and the like. In such matters the pastors, as the reasonable ones, should rightly give way to the people for peace's sake, and instruct them, where such ringing is wrongly used, that it be well used from now on

**Allstedt 1533.** The *pro pace* ringing stays, but "the abuse with the Ave Maria" is gone, and the people are to pray for peace and give thanks. **Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt und das Amt Allstedt*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 511):

> Wo es auch in den dorfern gewonheit ist gewesen, das man des morgens oder des abents pro pace hat geleutet, do sollen es die pfarrer nochmals bleiben lassen, doch sollen sie das volk daneben vormanen, das sie als denn gott umb einen zeitlichen friede mit ernst und vleis bitten wollen, auch darneben fur alle gnade und wolthat danksagung thun, nachdem der misbrauch mit dem ave Maria abgethan, dann solch leuten nicht vor einen gottes dienst wie etwan gehalten wird, sondern das dadurch das volk zu danksagung und wie berurt umb friede zu bieten ermanet sei, und daran unterschied des tages zu erkennen. Wo auch Thomas Müntzer das leuten zur predigt abgeschaft, do sol man es, wie vor alters geschehen wiederumb anfahen und nicht unterlassen

Where also it hath been the custom in the villages to ring *pro pace* in the morning or the evening, there the pastors shall let it still remain; yet they shall withal admonish the people that they then pray God earnestly and diligently for temporal peace, and also give thanks for all grace and benefits, since the abuse with the Ave Maria hath been done away; for such ringing is not held for a divine service, as it once was, but that thereby the people be admonished to thanksgiving and, as aforesaid, to pray for peace, and thereby to know the division of the day. Where also Thomas Müntzer abolished the ringing to the sermon, there one shall begin it again as was done of old, and not leave it off

**The Palatinate 1546: peace, workers and the Passion. Kurpfalz, provisional *Kirchenordnung*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 96):

> Es scheinet auch nutzlich, das morgens und abents die glocken pro pace geleut werde, wie auch die alten gethon haben, und das volck darbei erindert wurde, fur gemeinen friden Got zu bitten, und auch die tagloner bei solchem zaichen in und aus irer arbeit giengen, item uf den mittag zu ailfen oder zum wenigsten uf den freytag die glock geleut würdet, zu erindern das volck des leidens Cristi.

It seemeth also profitable that the bell be rung *pro pace* morning and evening, as the ancients also did, and that the people be thereby reminded to pray God for the common peace, and also that the day-labourers go to and from their work at such a sign; item, that the bell be rung at midday at eleven, or at the least on Friday, to remind the people of the sufferings of Christ.

**Noon and the Turk.** Wolfenbüttel moves the *pro pace* to eleven o'clock daily, as a prayer for peace, good government and against the Turk. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 71):

> Pro pace. Alle middage, wenn de klocke elfen sleyt, schal men in jeweliker parkercken de klocke slan edder lüden pro pace, dat is, dat de lüde dardorch vermanet werden, tho biddende Got umme frede und gut regiment, darmit wy ock bidden vor de overicheit wedder unse vyende, wedder den Türken etc., darane is uns vele gelegen.

*Pro pace.* Every midday, when the clock striketh eleven, one shall strike or ring the bell in every parish church *pro pace*; that is, that the people be thereby admonished to pray God for peace and good government, whereby we also pray for the magistrates against our enemies, against the Turk, etc., wherein much lieth for us.

**The three daily prayer bells.** Lüneburg and Hoya ring morning, noon and evening. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 552):

> Weil auch gebreuchlich, das die betglocken abends, morgens und zu mittage geleutet werden, so sol das volk vermanet werden, wenn solchs geschicht, das sie ihr gebet zu Gott dem Herrn für friede und alle zeitliche und ewige wolfart thun und ihr gesinde auch darzu halten, sie sein im hause, im felde oder wo einer ist, und das sie sich des nicht schemen

Since it is also customary that the prayer bells be rung at evening, morning and midday, the people shall be admonished, when that is done, to make their prayer to God the Lord for peace and all temporal and eternal welfare, and to hold their household thereto also, whether they be in the house, in the field, or wherever one is, and that they be not ashamed of it

Hoya gives the prayer to be said "upon the ringing *pro pace*". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1143):

> Beware uns, lieber himlischer Vater, und deine ganze christenheit diesen tag oder nacht und allezeit für allem ubel, für des leidigen teufels drauen, für einem schnellen, bösen, unversehenen todt, für greuliche plage unsers leibes, für feur und wassersnoth und für allen unsern feinden, als Türken, Moscowiter, babst und allen ketzern und tyrannen und für aller gefehrligkeit, verleihe gnediglich deinen segen und friede deinen kindern, erhalt auch unsere pastorn und obrigkeit sampt allen haushaltern, auf das wir dich recht erkennen, fürchten und vertrauen, in ruhe und friede leben und deinen segen bey uns entpfinden mögen. Amen

Keep us, dear heavenly Father, and thy whole Christendom, this day or night and at all times, from all evil, from the threatenings of the wretched devil, from a sudden, evil, unforeseen death, from grievous plague of our body, from fire and flood, and from all our enemies, as the Turks, Muscovites, the pope and all heretics and tyrants, and from all danger. Graciously grant thy blessing and peace to thy children; preserve also our pastors and magistrates, together with all householders, that we may rightly know, fear and trust thee, live in rest and peace, and feel thy blessing among us. Amen

**The Ave and Salve abolished or recast.**

- **Coburg 1554/55**: the three pulses morning and evening "which in the papacy were called the Ave Maria and Salve" are to cease, with the weather-ringing, "so that we be not counted papistical"; but the magistrate may have one pulse rung for workers or for shutting the gates. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung* of the visitation, 1554/55** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

> Zum sibenden, das die drei puls mit der glocken zu morgends und abents, welchs man im babstumb das Ave Maria und salve genant, sol umb der frembden und benachbarten leute willen, domit man uns nicht vor bebstisch achte, desgleichen das geleut zum wetter vorbleiben. Do aber die obrikait zur morgenstunde umb der arbeiter leut willen oder zum thorschlissen einen puls wolten thuen lassen, sol inen frei stehen.

Seventhly, that the three pulses with the bell morning and evening, which in the papacy were called the Ave Maria and Salve, shall cease for the sake of strangers and neighbouring folk, so that we be not counted papistical; likewise the ringing for the weather. But if the magistrates would have one pulse rung at the morning hour for the sake of the working people, or for the shutting of the gates, it shall be free to them.

- **Heilbronn 1532**: the council abolished the evening *Salve* but kept the ringing at the same hour, followed by singing and prayer for peace, with a sign rung on the prayer bell. **Heilbronn, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 17/1, p. 305):

> Dweyll ain ersamer radt das salve zu abent zeyt abgestelt, hat ir weyßhait an die stat alle wercktag zur selben abent zeyt wie bißher zum salve zu leutten, und, so ußgeleut, die lateinischs und teutschs schulmaister oder ir vicarii und schuler erscheinen sollen, ain gesang umb gmain friden zu halten, darbey auch ain diacon erscheinen und das beyweßend volck, umb gmain friden zu bitten, ermanen, mittel sollichs bets mit der betglockhen ain zaichen alß bißher geleut werden solle.

Whereas an honourable council hath abolished the *Salve* at eventide, their wisdom hath [ordered] in its stead that every working day at the same evening hour one ring as hitherto to the *Salve*, and, when it hath been rung out, the Latin and German schoolmasters or their deputies and scholars shall appear to hold a song for the common peace; a deacon also shall appear thereat and admonish the people present to pray for the common peace; [and] in the midst of such prayer a sign shall be rung with the prayer bell, as hitherto.

- **Lichtenberg 1579**: the Ave bell is no longer to be a threefold pulse but one continuous pulse, a plain morning and evening bell. **Lichtenberg, *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg*, 1579** (Sehling 18, p. 377):

> Zum Sechsten soll das Ave Mariae leutten, wie man es nennt, hinfürtter nicht ein trinus, sondern ein Continuus pulsus sein, das es für ein morgen und abent Glock oder leutten gehalten werde.

Sixthly, the Ave Maria ringing, as it is called, shall henceforth be not a threefold but a continuous pulse, that it be held for a morning and evening bell or ringing.

**The Friday bell for the Passion.** The Friday ringing at the hour of the crucifixion was kept by some orders, as at the Palatinate in 1546 (above). **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 741), having abolished weather-ringing:

> Aber das leuten, so am freitag zur gedechtnus des leidens und sterbens Christi geschickt, ist nicht zu verwerfen und, wes sich alle und jede christen dabei zu erinnern haben, soll weitleuftiger zu gelegener zeit durch den pfarrherrn vermeldet werden.

But the ringing which is done on Friday in remembrance of the suffering and death of Christ is not to be rejected; and what all and every Christian is to call to mind thereby shall be set forth more at large, at a fitting time, by the pastor.

Hohenlohe 1582, on the other hand, abolishes the Friday *Tenebrae* ringing outright and puts a ringing to the Friday litany in its place (§9.5.5).

**Other examples.**

- **Breslau 1585**: in time of plague the council asks those in the street, when the evening *pro pace* is rung, to kneel and pray, and orders the ringing lengthened (Sehling 3, pp. 405–406).
- **Lippe 1571**: the prayer bell at morning, noon and evening is kept "for many moving reasons", but not as though it must be kept; where it has lapsed it need not be restored. The preachers are to explain where the *pro pace* ringing came from, and how it fell into abuse under the papacy "as if it were a service done to the Virgin Mary" (Sehling 21, p. 442).

#### 9.5.4 Bells within the Mass

**The question.** In the Roman Mass a small bell (*Schelle*, *campanula*) was rung at the Sanctus and at the elevation of the host and chalice, and the tower bell was often tolled as well. The evangelical orders dropped the Canon, but several kept the elevation for a time, and some kept the bell with it.

**A bell sign before the consecration.** The earliest Prussian and Livonian orders keep a sign with the little bell between the Preface and the consecration:

- **Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 32):

> Auf die volendeten prefation und consecration gibt man ein zeichen mit der schellen, darnach so bald elevirt der priester beideteil des sacraments ane mittel nacheinander. Unter des und so bald die prefation samt der evangelischen benediction aus ist, singet der chor sanctus deütsch oder lateinisch nach gelegenheit, mit wenig noten.

Upon the finished Preface and consecration a sign is given with the little bell; thereafter straightway the priest elevateth both parts of the Sacrament, without interval, one after the other. Meanwhile, and as soon as the Preface together with the evangelical blessing is ended, the choir singeth the Sanctus in German or Latin as occasion serveth, with few notes.

- **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 16):

> Auf die predigt folget die prefatio, welche der priester deutsch singet bis auf das per Christum, inclusive. Da geb man bald ein zeichen mit eim glöcklein. Dar nach so bald sol der priester zum ersten das brot auf der pateen in die hand

> nemen, und sich ob dem altar umkeren zum volck, und die wort der benedeiung oder consecration wol laut, deutsch und vernemlich sprechen.

Upon the sermon followeth the Preface, which the priest singeth in German as far as the *per Christum*, inclusive. Then let a sign be given straightway with a little bell. Thereafter straightway shall the priest first take the bread upon the paten into his hand, and turn himself at the altar to the people, and speak the words of blessing or consecration well aloud, in German and distinctly.

- **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 90):

> Auf die praefation folget die consecratio gegen dem volke, wenn das zeichen mit dem glöcklein gegeben ist. Bald singt das chor sanctus, Esaiae dem propheten etc.

Upon the Preface followeth the consecration toward the people, when the sign with the little bell hath been given. Straightway the choir singeth the Sanctus, *Jesaia dem Propheten*, etc.

**Ringing at the elevation.** The Danish *Ordinatio* of 1537, which stands behind the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542, leaves the elevation to the minister's liberty, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom". **Denmark, *Ordinatio ecclesiastica*, 1537, from Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

> Et subinde a verbis decenti elevatione, si ita visum fuerit ministro elevet sonantibus interim cymbalis iuxta consuetum. Nam in his servanda est libertas christiana, ita tarnen ut de hac populus ante satis praemoneatur et nihil horum mutetur sine consensu et mandato superintendentis.

And forthwith after the words let him elevate with a seemly elevation, if it so seem good to the minister, the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom. For in these things Christian liberty is to be kept; yet so that the people be sufficiently forewarned of it beforehand, and that nothing of these things be changed without the consent and command of the superintendent.

Under the Interim the Ansbach *Auctuarium* ordered both the elevation and the bell. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548** (Interim order; Sehling 11, p. 327):

> Item es sollen auch die priester nach gewönlichem alten gebrauch die beede gestalt des heiligen sacraments aufheben und darzu leuten oder klingen lassen.

Item, the priests also shall, after the customary old usage, lift up both kinds of the holy Sacrament, and have [the bell] rung or tinkled thereto.

At Hof the elevation with a threefold pulse of the bell survived until about 1560. The order of 1592 records its passing. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 407):

> Elevatio autem benedicti panis et vini cum trino campanulae pulsu, qua maiores nostri ad insignem movebantur pietatem, pectora percutientes genuaque flectentes coram Christo Salvatore, quem pane et vino quasi velatum spectabant, ante annos ferme triginta, pastore tum d. doctore Johanne Streitbergero, abrogata est, quod haec ceremonia in caeteris marchionatus ecclesiis locum amplius non haberet.

But the elevation of the blessed bread and wine with a threefold pulse of the little bell, whereby our forefathers were moved to notable piety, beating their breasts and bending their knees before Christ the Saviour, whom they beheld as it were veiled in the bread and wine, was abrogated almost thirty years ago, Dr Johann Streitberger being then pastor, because this ceremony no longer had place in the other churches of the margraviate.

Anhalt in 1568 still kept the elevation on high feasts, without mention of a bell (Sehling 2, p. 570; quoted in Chapter 12, §12.10.6).

**A bell to call the communicants.** Two orders ring a bell in the Mass to call the communicants forward. At Hatzkerode the sign is given *during the German Sanctus*. This is the only bell in the corpus rung at the Sanctus. **Hatzkerode, *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

> Nach geschener predigt sol ein deutsch lied ader das deutsche sanctus Jesaia, dem propheten, das geschach nach gefallen des pfarhers, gesungen werden. Indes sol mit der glocke ein zeichen geben werden, alsdan sollen die

> communicanten in den chor gehen und zur rechten die manne, zur linken die frauen und junkfrauen treten.

After the sermon is done, a German song or the German Sanctus, *Jesaia dem Propheten*, shall be sung, as it pleaseth the pastor. Meanwhile a sign shall be given with the bell; then shall the communicants go into the choir, and the men stand on the right, the women and maidens on the left.

**Haldensleben, *Ordo caeremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis*, 1564** (Sehling 2, p. 457):

> 6. Post concionem vero accedunt ad altare communicaturi per campanulam quandam a custode convocati.

6. But after the sermon those who are to communicate come to the altar, called together by the custos with a certain little bell.

**A choir bell.** At Königsberg in 1568 "the little bell in the choir" is rung after the early sermon to call the cantor and scholars (§9.5.5).

**The Sacrament to the sick.** The medieval viaticum went through the streets with light and bell. The orders divide:

- **Baden 1533** still has the Sacrament carried to the sick "with light and bells going before" (Sehling 16, p. 510).
- **Brandenburg-Ansbach 1556** lets a sign be given with the bell, "yet distinctly", when the minister goes to the sick (Sehling 11, p. 336, quoted in §9.5.7). The editor notes that this is neither the passing bell nor the Catholic bell that called the faithful to follow the Sacrament.
- **Transylvania 1543**: the minister goes to the sick "without candles, little bells and other pomp, which entice the unlearned to idolatry" (Sehling 24, p. 196).
- **Micron 1554/1565** (Reformed) rejects "altars, lights, little bells, vestments" altogether. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 615):

> haben darumb keinswegs solche ceremonien angenomen, die eitel und unütz sind oder zu einiger abgötterey zihen und Christum Jesum in seinem priestertumb verfinstern, als da sind: altaren, lichten, schellen, kleider, denen etwas geheimnuß zugeschriben wird, und was dergleichen ding mehr sind.

[we] have therefore in no wise received such ceremonies as are vain and unprofitable, or draw to any idolatry and darken Christ Jesus in his priesthood: as are altars, lights, little bells, vestments, to which some mystery is ascribed, and whatever more such things there be.

**Not found.** The corpus has:

- **No Sanctus bell as such.** The word *Sanctusglocke* (or any compound of it) does not occur. The Hatzkerode bell during the German Sanctus calls the communicants; it does not mark the Sanctus.
- **No ringing during the Lord's Prayer in the Mass.** The Lord's Prayer is tied to bells only outside the Mass: the daily prayer bells (§9.5.3), and the Friday bell at eleven, at which, according to a later folk custom cited by the Hohenlohe editor, those in the field said an Our Father (Sehling 15, p. 452, editor's note).
- **No ringing at the *Gloria in excelsis*, at Easter or otherwise.** The festal bells of Easter belong to the summons and the chiming of the feast (§9.5.1), not to the Gloria.
- **No altar bell at the words of institution** after the elevation fell away. The bell before the consecration survives only in Prussia 1525, Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570.

### 9.5.5 Bells at the *Te Deum*, the litany and other chants

**Ringing during the *Te Deum*.** In Prussia the bell was rung during the German *Te Deum* at the end of Matins, to summon the people to the sermon and the Mass that followed. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 4, p. 67):

> darauf thut der diacon ader kirchendiener ein kurze ermanung vom heiligen sacrament für die, so communiciren wöllen, an stadt eines capitels; auf die ermanung singt die ganze kirche das deudsch Te deum laudamus, darunter wird zur predigt geleut und das lied Jesus Christus unser heiland, fur der predigt gesungen.

thereupon the deacon or minister of the church maketh a short exhortation concerning the holy Sacrament for those who will communicate, in the stead of a chapter; upon the exhortation the whole church singeth the German *Te Deum laudamus*, under

which the bell is rung to the sermon, and the song *Jesus Christus unser Heiland* is sung before the sermon.

The Prussian order of 1568 repeats it, and adds a choir bell. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 79):

> Sobald diese predig geschlossen, soll man mit dem kleinen glöcklein auf dem chor leuten und sich der cantor mit den schulgesellen und knaben in die kirche finden. [...] Nach dem symbolo lieset ein knabe eine lektion herniden fur dem altar gegen dem volk, wie alle lektiones sollen gelesen werden und folget darauf das Benedictus dominus deus Israel cum Antiphona, oder das deutsch Te deum laudamus Lutheri: O gott, dich loben wir, o gott, wir danken dir etc. Unterdess leutet man wiederum mit der grossen glocke und singet die ganze kirche nach dem Benedictus oder Te deum laudamus: Wir glauben etc.

As soon as this sermon is concluded, one shall ring with the little bell in the choir, and the cantor with the school assistants and boys shall betake themselves into the church. [...] After the Creed a boy readeth a lesson below before the altar toward the people, as all lessons shall be read, and thereupon followeth the *Benedictus Dominus Deus Israel* with the antiphon, or Luther's German *Te Deum laudamus*, *O Gott, dich loben wir, o Gott, wir danken dir*, etc. Meanwhile one ringeth again with the great bell, and the whole church singeth after the *Benedictus* or *Te Deum laudamus*: *Wir glauben*, etc.

**All the bells at the Christmas *Te Deum*.** At Hof's Christmas Matins the organ plays the responsory, the German *Te Deum* alternates between organ and choir, and all the bells are rung until it ends. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592, Christmas Day** (Sehling 11, p. 413):

> II. Lectio ex novo testamento. Hac finita organicen more consueto modulatur responsorium, sequente choro. Verbum caro factum est. Mox concio habetur. Hanc excipt canticum sanctorum Ambrosii et Augustini germanicum: Herr Got, dich loben wir. Incipienten organicinem sequiitur totus chorus et ita per vices finitur cantus. Unter diesem gsang leutet man mit allen glocken bis zu end desselben.

II. The lesson from the New Testament. This being finished, the organist playeth the responsory in the customary manner, the choir following: *Verbum caro factum est*. Straightway the sermon is held. After it cometh the canticle of Saints Ambrose and Augustine in German, *Herr Gott, dich loben wir*. The organist beginning, the whole choir followeth, and so the song is finished in turns. During this song one ringeth with all the bells until the end of the same.

**The litany.** Hohenlohe rings the largest bell when the Friday litany begins, so that those in the field and at home may join in the prayer, and abolishes the *Tenebrae* ringing. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchen- und Schulordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 15, p. 452):

> [12.] Von leiten deß Tenebre uf den freytag. Nachdem zum gemeinen gebett uf dem freytag nicht jederman kommen kan, sonder durch notwendige gescheft uf dem veld wie auch die bestelte taglöner darvon abgehalten werden, so wöllen, ordnen und bevehlen wir, sobald die letaney angefangen, das alsdann mit der grösten glocken ein gut zeichen geleitet, dardurch meniglich, so uf dem veld oder in den heußern, des gemeinen gebetts erinnert, uf das, ob sie woll bey der versambleten gemein in der kirchen mit dem leib nicht gegenwertig, doch nach dem geist und mit andechtigem gebett darvor nicht abgesondert seien, sonder dartzu ermanet werden. Dargegen soll das tenebreleuten in allen kirchen und an allen orten in unserer grafschaft gentzlichen abgeschaft sein und nicht mehr gestattet werden.

[12.] Of the ringing of the *Tenebrae* on Friday. Forasmuch as not every one can come to the common prayer on Friday, but [some] are kept from it by necessary business in the field, as also the hired day-labourers, we will, ordain and command that, as soon as the litany is begun, a good sign be rung with the greatest bell, whereby every one in the field or in the houses may be reminded of the common prayer; to the end that, although they be not present in body with the assembled congregation in the church, they may yet not be separated from it in spirit and in devout prayer, but be admonished thereto. On the other hand the *Tenebrae* ringing shall be wholly abolished in all churches and in all places in our county, and no longer be permitted.

At Regensburg the litany is sung *under* the ringing, while the people gather for the early sermon and communion. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 461):

> Erstlich wird in beiden kirchen, der neuen pfarre und zu S. Oswald, unter dem leuten gesungen durch die deudschen schulen und gemein die preußisch letanei oder etwas de tempore deudsches.

First, in both churches, the New Parish and St Oswald's, the Prussian litany, or something German of the season, is sung by the German schools and the congregation under the ringing.

**Hymn stanzas.** No order prescribes ringing during a particular stanza of a hymn. What the orders have instead is ringing during a whole chant that ends one part of the service and leads into the next: the *Te Deum* at Matins (Prussia, Hof), the litany (Hohenlohe, Regensburg). The Hohenlohe editor records a later folk custom of ringing on Good Friday while "O Lamm Gottes" was sung (Sehling 15, p. 452, editor's note), but that is nineteenth-century evidence and is not in the order.

The Litany itself is treated in Chapter 13, §13.22.

#### 9.5.6 Bells for the dead

**Ringing at a death, as a reminder to the living.** The Saxon visitors kept the bell rung for the dead, but gave it a new reason. **Meissen, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen*, 1540** (Sehling 2, p. 52):

> Vom leuten, so jemand gestorben ist. Es sol den toten geleutet werden, auf das die lebendigen auch bedenken die stund und zeit ires sterbens und ir leben besseren etc. Dieses anzeigen mit dem geleut sol bald nach irem sterben geschehen. Es sol auch forthin frue und des abends, wie bisher auch geschehen, pro pace geleutet werden, auf das das volk erinnert werde fur einen gemeinen fried der christenheit zu bitten. Leutgeld von toten. Es sol dem kirchner das leutgeld, wie fur lange gegeben ist, folgen.

Of ringing when any one hath died. The bell shall be rung for the dead, that the living also may consider the hour and time of their own dying, and amend their life, etc. This announcing with the bell shall be done soon after their death. Also henceforth the bell shall be rung *pro pace* early and at evening, as hath been done hitherto, that the people be reminded to pray for a common peace of Christendom. Ringing-money for the dead. The ringing-money shall go to the sexton, as it hath been given of old.

**Saturday ringing for the souls abolished.** The weekly ringing "for all faithful souls" went:

- **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 721):

> Zur predigt, messe und vesper, auch den todten mag man leuten, doch das es zur vesper und den todten auch frue zur lection bei einem leuten mit einer glocken bleibe. Desgleichen mag man pro pace leuten, doch das das folk des wol bericht werde. […] Das leuten fur die seelen am sonnabent soll abgeen.

To the sermon, Mass and Vespers, also for the dead, one may ring; yet so that to Vespers and for the dead, also early to the lesson, it remain at one ringing with one bell. Likewise one may ring *pro pace*, yet so that the people be well instructed therein. […] The ringing for the souls on Saturday shall cease.

- **Reuss, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV, 1552** (Sehling 2, p. 156), which in the same article abolishes weather-ringing:

> Wetterleuten. Von diesem artikel ist sonderlich gehandelt, und eintrechtiglich beschlossen, weil das leuten an vielen orten unrichtigkeit gebirt, das solchs auch allenthalben sol abgethan sein und bleiben, doch sol solches mit vleis uf den canzeln praecavirt, und das volk one das zum gebet allezeit treulich vermanet werden. Das leuten am sonnabent allen gleubigen seelen soll auch abgeschafft werden, dann es ergerlich, und stinkt nach dem pabstumb.

Weather-ringing. This article was specially dealt with, and it was resolved with one accord that, since the ringing breedeth disorder in many places, it also shall be and remain done away everywhere; yet this shall be diligently forewarned of from the pulpits, and the people, without it, faithfully admonished at all times to prayer. The ringing on Saturday for all faithful souls shall also be abolished, for it is offensive and smelleth of the papacy.

**Equality and fees.** Ulm's undated visitation articles of the early 1530s (Moderate Reformed) ask "that in the ringing in memory of the dead equality be kept" (Sehling 17/2, p. 193). In practice the number of bells was a matter of fees. Danzig's burial order of 1578 sets the schoolboys' pay by the bells rung. **Danzig, *Begräbnisordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 4, p. 191):

> das auf dem schlag zwei nachmittag die schüler fur der thuren sollen anfangen zu singen bis zu halb dreien, und dafur soll man ihnen geben, wan eine glocke gelautet wirdt, zehen groschen von zweien glocken zwanzig groschen, und wan alle glocken gelautet werden, 40 groschen.

that at the stroke of two in the afternoon the scholars shall begin to sing before the doors until half past two, and for that they shall be given, when one bell is rung, ten groschen; for two bells, twenty groschen; and when all the bells are rung, 40 groschen.

**Not during the sermon.** Herford 1532 silences "all bells, be it for the dead or not" while the sermon is preached (§9.4.4).

**Burial without bells.** The bell was withheld as a mark of exclusion or of grief:

- **The despisers of the Sacrament. Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 723):

> Wurd auch jemands so halstarrig und rohe sein, das es uber und wider gescheene vormanung und bedraung nicht zu kirchen gienge und wider gottes wort horet, noch das hochwirdige sacrament bei seinem gesund entpfinge, auch in seiner krankheit desselben nicht begeret und also on das hochwirdig sacrament sturbe, den soll man unbeleut und unbeleitet mit den schulern in still begraben.

If also any one were so stiff-necked and rude that, over and against admonition and threatening given, he went not to church, nor heard God's word, nor received the most worthy Sacrament in his health, nor desired it in his sickness, and so died without the most worthy Sacrament, him shall one bury in silence, without bells and without escort of the scholars.

- **Unbaptized infants. Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 432), which buries them in the churchyard "for the comfort of the sorrowing parents", but without bells:

> Sondern sollen zum Trost der betrübten Eltern auff die Kirchhöfe oder Sepulturn anderer Christen und getaufften Kinder begraben werden, Jedoch ohn Glockengeleuth und Gesenge der Kirchendiener und Schüler, Nicht der meinung, das wir die kleinen, ungetaufften Kinder, insonderheit, so von fromen, Christgleubigen Eltern im Heiligen Ehestande geboren sein, verdammen

But they shall be buried, for the comfort of the sorrowing parents, in the churchyards or burial places of other Christians and baptized children; yet without ringing of bells and singing of the ministers of the church and scholars: not in the meaning that we condemn the little unbaptized children, especially those born of godly, Christian-believing parents in holy wedlock

Limpurg 1610, by contrast, rings "the small bell" for children carried to burial "before or after baptism" in its village of Münster (Sehling 16, p. 623).

#### 9.5.7 Bells at baptisms and weddings

**Baptism.** Where a child was baptized outside the regular service, a bell called the congregation to witness it:

- **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 121):

> Wir halten auch für nützlich, so ausserhalb der gemeinen predig oder kirchenversamlung ein kind getauft werden solle, in massen kurtz hievor gemeldet, daß ein zeichen mit einer glocken beschehe, damit andere leuth dardurch, zum taufhandel zu kommen, vermahnet werden.

We hold it also profitable, if a child is to be baptized outside the common sermon or assembly of the church, as was mentioned a little before, that a sign be given with a bell, that other people may thereby be admonished to come to the act of baptism.

- **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode*, 1556** (Sehling 11, p. 336):

> So man aber in kürchen taufet, soll man mit dem kleinen glocklin darzu leuten und das zeichen des creuzes auslassen. […] Bei den kranken kein corrock gebrauchen, tamen sit liberum in suis locis, und (doch underschidlich) mit der glocken ein zeichen gegeben werden.

But when one baptizeth in church, one shall ring thereto with the little bell, and leave out the sign of the cross. […] With the sick no surplice [is] to be used, *yet let it be free in their places*; and (yet distinctly) a sign [is] to be given with the bell.

- **Limpurg 1610** settles a complaint by ordering the ringing before baptism with the small bell in all country churches. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 623):

> 1. Das Leuten bey der Künder Tauff. Solch Leutten soll hünfüro auff dem Landt bey allen Kürchen (außerhalb der Statt Gailendorff), es wer gleich hiebevor in einem oder andern Ortt inn gebrauch geweesen oder nicht, vor der Tauff mit dem klainen Glöckhlin beschehen unnd verrichtet werden.

1. Of the ringing at the baptism of children. Such ringing shall henceforth be done and performed in the country at all churches (except the town of Gaildorf), whether it was in use before in one place or another or not, before the baptism, with the small bell.

- **Heilbronn**, around 1529, kept the bell for "child baptism" when it stopped ringing for the Mass and Vespers (Sehling 17/1, p. 226, editor's introduction).

The Regensburg editor notes that a bell for baptism was unknown in the Middle Ages (Sehling 13, p. 436, editor's note), so this is a new evangelical use, not a survival.

**Weddings.** At Hof the bell for a wedding service is rung half an hour later than usual. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 430):

> Wann eine hochzeit vorhanden, wird ein halbe stund lengsamer geleutet, dann sönsten gebreuchlich

When there is a wedding, the bell is rung half an hour later than is otherwise customary

#### 9.5.8 Bells against storms

The abolition of weather-ringing, with the bell baptism behind it, is treated in Chapter 13, §13.15.5, which quotes Saxony 1528 and 1580 and summarizes Hohenlohe 1582 and the other territories. The orders fall into three groups:

- **Kept, re-explained as a call to prayer**: Saxony 1528 (Sehling 1, pp. 170–171), the Upper Palatinate 1579 (one bell at night), Hohenlohe 1582 (one bell, not all, and not as long as the storm lasts), Limpurg 1610 (the great bell only, for a quarter of an hour).
- **Abolished**: Ulm (undated articles, Moderate Reformed, "as it hath begun"), Reuss 1552 (§9.5.6), Coburg 1554/55 (§9.5.3), Thüngen 1564, Saxony 1580, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 (§9.5.1), and the Oldenburg visitations of 1609–1610, which keep the prayer bell instead (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1212).
- **Asked about at visitation**: Hohenlohe 1558 asks whether there is ringing against weather, fog, frost or heat (Sehling 15, p. 122).

#### 9.5.9 Lesser signals: the sermon glass and the alms bell

**The end of the sermon.** At Zerbst the sexton turned an hour-glass when the preacher went up into the pulpit, and rang a little bell when it had run out. **Zerbst, *Vereinbarungen des gesammten Ministeriums*, 1545** (Sehling 2, p. 593):

> Uf das aber solliches gehalten moge werden, soll ein seiger von drei virtel stunden vor dem canzel stehen, damit der prediger sehen moge, wann er schliessen soll, und der custer soll auch zween zaiger, einen von einer stunden, den andern von dreien virtel stunden bei sich behalten, und den saiger von einer stunden zur hochmessen, und den zeiger von dreien virtel stunden aber zu allen andern predigen gebrauchen und umkeren, so bald der predicant uf die canzel gehet, und wann also der seiger vor einer oder dreien virtel stunden ausgelaufen, so soll er mit einer darzu verordenten schellen clingen, damit der predicant schliesse und der gemeine urlauben moge.

But that this may be kept, a three-quarter-hour glass shall stand before the pulpit, that the preacher may see when he should conclude; and the sexton also shall keep by him two glasses, one of an hour, the other of three quarters of an hour, and use the hour-glass at High Mass and the three-quarter glass at all other sermons, and turn it as soon as the preacher goeth up into the pulpit; and when the glass of one hour or of three quarters hath run out, he shall tinkle with a little bell appointed thereto, that the preacher may conclude and dismiss the congregation.

**The alms bell.** At Brandis the churchwardens, or someone they appoint, go round "under all sermons, or before and after," with a little bell to collect alms. **Brandis, *Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 533):

> darzu sollen sie under allen predigen, oder aber vor und nach, mit einem schellen glocklein umbgehn oder zu geen bestellen, und das almusen wie zu Grimme und anderswo von den leuten bitten, und den armen wie berurt widerumb austeilen.

thereto they shall go about, or appoint someone to go, with a little hand-bell during all the sermons, or else before and after, and ask the alms of the people, as at Grimma and elsewhere, and distribute it again to the poor, as aforesaid.

The Württemberg common-chest orders give the street collectors for the poor "a bell or little bell, whereby every one may be reminded to give alms" (Sehling 16, p. 96; repeated at Sehling 16, p. 202, and Sehling 6/1, p. 263). This was a street bell, not a church bell.

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## 9.6 Table by order

**Key.**

- The orders are listed by date.
- "—" means that nothing on the point was found in the passages examined. It does not mean that the order forbids it.
- Each cell reports only what the order itself says. The § column gives the sections of this chapter where the evidence is quoted or cited.

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg castle church, 1525 | 1 | Only at the Sunday *Te Deum* and German songs | — | A signal to singing and sermon, "not for the pomp of the feasts" | 9.3.1, 9.5.1 |
| Prussia, *Artikel der Ceremonien*, 1525 | 4 | — | — | Sign with the little bell after Preface and consecration; elevation follows | 9.5.4 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | "All the organs piped", if it served the young | — | "All the bells", likewise | 9.3.1 |
| Saxony, *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 | 1 | — | — | *Pacem* ringing kept and taught aright; weather-ringing re-explained as a call to prayer | 9.5.3, 9.5.8 |
| Hamburg, 1529 | 5 | Four organists; silent at Passiontide; at weddings by private arrangement | Minstrels play the bridal party to the churchyard | Sextons to "strike all the bells evenly and rightly" | 9.3.6, 9.4.4, 9.5.2 |
| Zwickau, visitation, 1529 | 1 | — | — | One bell to Vespers, the lesson and the dead; *pro pace* allowed; Saturday ringing for souls abolished | 9.5.2, 9.5.6 |
| Brandis, 1529 | 1 | — | — | Alms collected with a hand-bell during sermons | 9.5.9 |
| Heilbronn, c. 1529 (editor's introduction) | 17/1 | — | — | Sexton to ring only to the early sermon and baptism, not to Mass or Vespers | 9.5.2, 9.5.7 |
| Riga, 1530 | 5 | — | — | Sign with a little bell before the consecration | 9.5.4 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ulm, decree of 1531 (editor's introduction) (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | — | No drums, wind or strings at weddings | — | 9.4.4 |
| Heilbronn, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532 | 17/1 | — | — | *Salve* abolished; evening ringing kept, with singing and prayer for peace and the prayer bell | 9.5.3 |
| Herford, 1532 | 21 | — | Drums, trumpets and pipes silent near the church during the sermon | All bells silent during the sermon, "be it for the dead or not" | 9.4.4, 9.5.6 |
| Allstedt, visitation, 1533 | 1 | — | — | *Pro pace* kept, Ave Maria abolished; ringing to the sermon restored | 9.5.2, 9.5.3 |
| Altenburg castle chapter, 1533 | 1 | — | — | One great bell on working days, more bells on Sundays and feasts | 9.5.1 |
| Baden, 1533 | 16 | — | — | Sacrament to the sick "with light and bells" | 9.5.4 |
| Zwickau, visitation, 1533 | 1 | — | Drumming on the church tower stopped during the sermon | Despisers of the Sacrament buried "without bells" | 9.4.5, 9.5.6 |
| Hatzkerode, 1534(?) | 2 | — | — | Bell sign during the German Sanctus to call communicants into the choir | 9.5.4 |
| Denmark, *Ordinatio*, 1537 (apparatus to Schleswig-Holstein 1542) | 23 | — | — | Elevation at liberty, "the bells meanwhile sounding according to custom" | 9.5.4 |
| Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537/1538 | 2 | Organ begins each German song; three or four choirs in alternation | — | — | 9.3.3 |
| Ulm, visitation articles, undated, early 1530s (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | — | — | "Equality" in ringing for the dead; weather-ringing to remain abolished | 9.5.6, 9.5.8 |
| Ansbach, mandate on figural singing, 1538 | 11 | — | Trombones and other instruments with the psalms at court, and at weddings in church | — | 9.4.1 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Esslingen, *Läuteordnung*, 1540 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | — | — | Fore-sign with the singing bell, second sign with the noon bell, then the sermon | 9.5.2 |
| Meissen, visitation, 1540 | 2 | — | — | Death bell "that the living may consider"; *pro pace* morning and evening; ringing-money | 9.5.6 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, 1542 | 6/2 | Organists to set the hymns; no love-songs or worldly songs | — | — | 9.3.7 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, 1542 | 23 | Latin Gloria alternates choir and organ; German Gloria, hymn and Creed "without organ" | — | — | 9.3.3 |
| Schönburg, 1542 | 2 | Pieces after the Kyrie, epistle, Creed and sermon; none at communion except on high feasts; a piece after communion; *Magnificat* alternatim | — | — | 9.3.4, 9.3.5 |
| Wolfenbüttel, 1543 | 6/1 | Organist paid by his skill; plays on Sundays; not after the sermon in the Mass | — | *Pro pace* daily at eleven | 9.3.1, 9.3.6, 9.5.3 |
| Transylvania, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543 | 24 | — | — | Sick communion "without candles, little bells" | 9.5.4 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 4 | — | — | Daily morning and evening ringing kept in villages; ringing to the sermon during the German *Te Deum* | 9.5.3, 9.5.5 |
| Bergedorf, 1544 | 5 | On feast days, only what the people have first sung through | — | — | 9.3.3 |
| Zerbst, 1545 | 2 | — | — | Little bell when the sermon's hour-glass runs out | 9.5.9 |
| Kurpfalz, provisional order, 1546 | 14 | — | — | *Pro pace* morning and evening, for workers too; eleven o'clock or Friday bell for the Passion | 9.5.3 |
| Bremen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1546 | 7/2.2 | — | Council's minstrels with trumpets, | — | 9.4.4 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | pipes and drums at weddings | | |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order) | 11 | — | — | Elevation of both kinds with ringing (Interim) | 9.5.4 |
| Reuss, 1552 | 2 | — | — | Weather-ringing and Saturday ringing for souls abolished | 9.5.6 |
| Regensburg, Justus Jonas, 1553 | 13 | Introit and ordinary played, not sung; communion hymns and Vespers alternatim | — | — | 9.3.3 |
| Coburg, visitation, 1554/55 | 1 | — | — | Ave and *Salve* pulses and weather-ringing cease; a work or gate bell allowed | 9.5.3 |
| Micron, *Ordinancien*, 1554 (German 1565) (Reformed) | 7/1 | — | — | "Little bells" rejected with altars and lights | 9.5.4 |
| Nördlingen, St George's, 1555 | 12 | Organ begins; three choirs; silent in Lent except the Annunciation | — | — | 9.3.3, 9.3.6 |
| Hamburg, 1556 | 5 | Before and after the sermon and at Vespers; between the verses of the German psalm; no worldly songs | — | — | 9.3.3, 9.3.5, 9.3.7 |
| Kurpfalz, 1556 | 14 | — | — | Bell sign for a baptism outside the service | 9.5.7 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, synod, 1556 | 11 | — | — | Little bell at baptism; bell sign for the sick | 9.5.4, 9.5.7 |
| Hohenlohe, visitation, 1558 | 15 | — | — | Asks whether there is ringing for the Ave, weather, fog, frost or heat | 9.5.8 |
| Thorn, 1560–1570 | 4 | Baptism "not under the singing or organ" | — | — | 9.3.6 |
| Haldensleben, 1564 | 2 | — | — | Custos's little bell calls the communicants to the altar | 9.5.4 |
| Lüneburg, 1564 | 6/1 | — | — | Prayer bells at evening, morning and noon | 9.5.3 |
| Thüngen, 1564 | 11 | — | — | Weather-ringing abolished; Friday | 9.5.3, 9.5.8 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | Passion bell "not to be rejected" | |
| Regensburg, 1567 | 13 | — | — | Litany sung "under the ringing" | 9.5.5 |
| Danzig, St Mary's, 1567 | 4 | — | — | Ringing and chiming on feasts and vigils left off | 9.5.1 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 | 4 | *Magnificat* alternatim; a piece after the *Nunc dimittis* | — | Little choir bell calls the scholars; great bell during the *Benedictus* or *Te Deum* | 9.3.5, 9.5.3, 9.5.5 |
| Gelnhausen, [1568] | 9 | Begins the *Veni Sancte Spiritus*; plays the first stanza of the psalm; pieces between; closes with a piece | — | Three signs at seven, half past seven and eight | 9.3.2, 9.5.2 |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4 | Office alternatim; at communion only three times; no worldly songs; silent in Rogation week | — | — | 9.3.3, 9.3.6 |
| Kurland, 1570 | 5 | — | — | Little bell before the consecration | 9.5.4 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, 1570 | 10 | — | Wedding piping and fiddling not to disturb the sermon | — | 9.4.4 |
| Lippe, 1571 | 21 | — | — | Prayer bell kept but not necessary; unbaptized infants buried without bells | 9.5.3, 9.5.6 |
| Stettin, visitation, 1573 | 4 | Articles for organists: no strangers, tuning, no dances, no fantasizing over the people's singing | Organists not to act as common minstrels | — | 9.3.7, 9.4.4 |
| Reutlingen, 1574 | 17/2 | Two stanzas sung, one played; none on communion days | — | — | 9.3.3, 9.3.6 |
| Schweinfurt, 1576 | 11 | Organ begins Kyrie and introit; a piece in place of the *Et in terra* | — | — | 9.3.2, 9.3.4 |
| Emden, *Organistenvertrag*, 1577 (Reformed) | 7/1 | Organist to serve the organ; no galliards or dances | "Christian music and other instruments" on feasts; tower-blowing; trombone in 1579 (editor) | Carillon | 9.4.2 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Danzig, burial order, 1578 | 4 | — | — | Fees by the number of bells | 9.5.6 |
| Lichtenberg, 1579 | 18 | — | — | Ave bell a continuous, not threefold, pulse | 9.5.3 |
| Upper Palatinate, 1579 | 13 | — | — | Weather-ringing by night with one bell, for prayer | 9.5.8 |
| Hoya, 1581 | 6/2 | — | — | Prayer bells morning, noon and evening, with a prayer *pro pace* | 9.5.3 |
| Henneberg, 1582 | 2 | Litany "without organ or figural music"; lower feasts without organ | — | — | 9.3.6 |
| Hohenlohe, 1582 | 15 | — | — | Greatest bell at the Friday litany; *Tenebrae* ringing abolished; one bell in storms | 9.5.5, 9.5.8 |
| Breslau, 1585 | 3 | — | — | Kneel in the street at the evening *pro pace* in plague-time | 9.5.3 |
| Saxe-Lauenburg, 1585 | 5 | — | — | Bells for Word and prayer only; weather and secular ringing forbidden; sexton alone rings; a clock or compass | 9.5.1, 9.5.2 |
| Danzig, wedding ordinances, 1590/1595 | 4 | — | Trumpets, fanfares and kettledrums forbidden at weddings | — | 9.4.4 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11 | Introit, responsory, *Te Deum* and *Magnificat* with organ; silent Advent II to Christmas Eve | — | Elevation bell ended c. 1560; all bells at the Christmas *Te Deum*; wedding bell half an hour later | 9.3.2, 9.3.6, 9.5.4, 9.5.5, 9.5.7 |
| Emden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1594 (Reformed) | 7/1 | Not during the singing or the service; only before and after | — | — | 9.3.1 |
| Strasbourg, 1598 | 20/1 | Defended against the Reformed; begins at the end of the ringing; plays what is to be sung; once or twice in a hymn; freer pieces after the blessing | — | — | 9.3.1, 9.3.2, 9.3.5 |

| Order | Vol. | Organ | Other instruments | Bells | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1601 (Reformed) | 22 | — | — | No chiming; three times with one bell, a little bell last; burials moderate | 9.5.1, 9.5.2 |
| Nordstrand, 1605 | 23 | — | Trumpets forbidden at weddings and feasts | — | 9.4.4 |
| Oldenburg, visitations, 1609–1610 | 7/2.1 | — | — | Weather-ringing forbidden; prayer bell kept | 9.5.8 |
| Limpurg, 1610 | 16 | — | — | Little bell before baptism and for children's burials; great bell a quarter-hour in storms | 9.5.6, 9.5.7, 9.5.8 |
| Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612 | 4 | — | Town pipers and fiddlers in the choir for figural music and nuptial Masses | Seven bells named; Sunday and weekday ringing set out; chiming by rank | 9.4.3, 9.5.1, 9.5.2 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615 | 17/1 | — | A fallen bride goes to church "without string-music" | — | 9.4.4 |
| Bischofswerda, 1676 (late) | 2 | The organist "preambulates" before each item | — | — | 9.3.2 |

## 9.7 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §9.6 and the text.

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Allstedt | *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt und das Amt Allstedt* | 1533 | 1, p. 511 | 9.5.3 |
| Ansbach | *Figural und coral zu ziemlicher zeit in der kirchen zu singen* | 1538 | 11, p. 397 | 9.4.1 |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) | *Mandat zum Glockenläuten* | 1601 | 22, p. 302 | 9.5.1 |
| Bergedorf | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 5, p. 389 | 9.3.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach (Interim order) | *Auctuarium* | 1548 | 11, p. 327 | 9.5.4 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach | *Vereinbarungen der Theologen auf der Synode* | 1556 | 11, p. 336 | 9.5.7 |
| Brandis | *Ordnung für die Stadt Brandis* | 1529 | 1, p. 533 | 9.5.9 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Calenberg-Göttingen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1542 | 6/2, p. 785 | 9.3.7 |
| Coburg | *Vorschaffung* of the visitation | 1554/55 | 1, p. 544 | 9.5.3 |
| Danzig | *Begräbnisordnung* | 1578 | 4, p. 191 | 9.5.6 |
| Danzig | *Kirchenordnung für Danzig* | 1612 | 4, pp. 202–203, 212 | 9.4.3, 9.5.2 |
| Denmark | *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* | 1537 | 23, p. 90 | 9.5.4 |
| Emden (Reformed) | *Organistenvertrag* | 1577 | 7/1, pp. 475–478 | 9.4.2 |
| Emden (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1594 | 7/1, p. 489 | 9.3.1 |
| Esslingen (Moderate Reformed) | *Läuteordnung für den Predigtgottesdienst* | 1540 | 17/2, p. 394 | 9.5.2 |
| Gelnhausen | *Kirchenordnung* | [1568] | 9, p. 652 | 9.3.2 |
| Haldensleben | *Ordo caeremoniarum ecclesiae Haldenslebensis* | 1564 | 2, p. 457 | 9.5.4 |
| Hamburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1529 | 5, p. 516 | 9.4.4 |
| Hamburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1556 | 5, p. 547 | 9.3.5 |
| Hatzkerode | *Kirchenordnunge* | 1534(?) | 2, p. 587 | 9.5.4 |
| Heilbronn | *Gottesdienstordnung* | 1532 | 17/1, p. 305 | 9.5.3 |
| Herford | *Kirchenordnung* | 1532 | 21, p. 171 | 9.4.4 |
| Hof | *Ordo ecclesiasticus* | 1592 | 11, pp. 407, 413, 430, 432 | 9.3.6, 9.5.4, 9.5.5, 9.5.7 |
| Hohenlohe | *Kirchen- und Schulordnung* | 1582 | 15, p. 452 | 9.5.5 |
| Hoya | *Kirchenordnung* | 1581 | 6/2, p. 1143 | 9.5.3 |
| Kurland | *Kirchenordnung* | 1570 | 5, p. 90 | 9.5.4 |
| Kurpfalz | provisional *Kirchenordnung* | 1546 | 14, p. 96 | 9.5.3 |
| Kurpfalz | *Kirchenordnung* | 1556 | 14, p. 121 | 9.5.7 |
| Lichtenberg | *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer des Amtes Lichtenberg* | 1579 | 18, p. 377 | 9.5.3 |
| Limpurg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1610 | 16, p. 623 | 9.5.7 |
| Lippe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1571 | 21, p. 432 | 9.5.6 |
| Luther | *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts* | 1526 | 1, p. 11 | 9.3.1 |
| Lüneburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 6/1, p. 552 | 9.5.3 |
| Meissen | *Ordnung der Visitatoren für die Stadt Meissen* | 1540 | 2, p. 52 | 9.5.6 |
| Micron (Reformed) | *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition | 1565 | 7/1, p. 615 | 9.5.4 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg | *Visitationsabschied* | 1570 | 10, p. 112 | 9.4.4 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Naumburg | *Kirchen-Ordnung* for St Wenzel | 1537/1538 | 2, p. 72 | 9.3.3 |
| Pomerania | *Agenda* | 1569 | 4, p. 439 | 9.3.3 |
| Prussia | *Artikel der Ceremonien* | 1525 | 4, p. 32 | 9.5.4 |
| Prussia | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 4, p. 67 | 9.5.3, 9.5.5 |
| Prussia | *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien* | 1568 | 4, pp. 75, 79 | 9.3.5, 9.5.5 |
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung* of Justus Jonas | 1553 | 13, p. 421 | 9.3.3 |
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1567 | 13, p. 461 | 9.5.5 |
| Reuss | *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Heinrich IV | 1552 | 2, p. 156 | 9.5.6 |
| Reutlingen | *Artikel der Schulvisitation* | 1574 | 17/2, p. 58 | 9.3.3 |
| Riga | *Kirchenordnung* | 1530 | 5, p. 16 | 9.5.4 |
| Saxe-Lauenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1585 | 5, p. 423 | 9.5.1 |
| Saxony (Ernestine) | *Unterricht der Visitatoren* | 1528 | 1, p. 170 | 9.5.3 |
| Schleswig-Holstein | *Kirchenordnung* | 1542 | 23, p. 146 | 9.3.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543/1615 | 17/1, p. 155 | 9.4.4 |
| Schönburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1542 | 2, pp. 170–171 | 9.3.4 |
| Stettin | *Visitations-Abschied* | 1573 | 4, p. 533 | 9.3.7 |
| Strasbourg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1598 | 20/1, pp. 602–603 | 9.3.1, 9.3.2, 9.3.5 |
| Thorn | *Kirchenordnung* | 1560–1570 | 4, p. 230 | 9.3.6 |
| Thüngen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 11, p. 741 | 9.5.3 |
| Wittenberg | *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt* | 1525 | 1, p. 699 | 9.3.1 |
| Wolfenbüttel | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543 | 6/1, pp. 45, 71 | 9.3.6, 9.5.3 |
| Zerbst | *Vereinbarungen des gesammten Ministeriums* | 1545 | 2, p. 593 | 9.5.9 |
| Zwickau | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1529 | 1, p. 721 | 9.5.6 |
| Zwickau | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1533 | 1, p. 723 | 9.4.5, 9.5.6 |

# Chapter 10. The Daily Office

This chapter follows the **canonical hours** (*horae canonicae*, *die sieben Gezeiten*, *Tagzeiten*) through the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. The medieval cursus had eight offices:

- Matins (*Mette*, *matutinae*, with its nocturns);
- Lauds (*laudes*);
- Prime, Terce, Sext and None (the "little hours");
- Vespers;
- Compline (*completorium*).

The chapter asks:

- Did the Lutherans reduce the system to two offices, morning and evening, as Luther is often said to have done? Or did fuller forms survive, and where?
- Where was the system changed, and how?
- **Who** prayed the offices? Schoolboys, canons and vicars, nuns, the congregation, cathedral chapters?
- Were there **prayer obligations** on pastors, vicars or students?
- **What did the offices look like?** Do the orders set out their liturgy?
- Were they sung in **Latin, German, or both**?
- Was the **medieval chant** kept, or were the pieces reset with new music?
- What did the new **catechism service** look like? How long was it, and what was its order?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §10.1 summarizes the findings, and §10.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §10.3 gives Luther's own rulings of 1523 and 1526.
- §10.4 shows where the full cursus survived: collegiate churches and cathedrals, the remaining canons and monks, and the women's convents.
- §10.5 shows where the system was cut down to morning and evening, and why.
- §10.6 asks who prayed the offices, and what obligations were laid on whom.
- §10.7 describes the shape of the reformed offices, with the *preces*, suffrages and Litany (§10.7.5).
- §10.8 deals with language, and §10.9 with the music.
- §10.10 describes the catechism service: its origins, hour and length, and its order in the Lutheran and Reformed churches, with a comparative table.
- §10.11 gathers the ceremonial of the offices and the catechism service: kneeling, the Litany before the altar, the two choirs, the place of the lesson, the children set in order, and the sign of the cross.
- §10.12 is a table by order, and §10.13 a concordance.

## 10.1 Summary of findings

**1. Luther did not reduce the office to two hours. He set two levels** (§10.3).

- **For the parish: two daily gatherings.** In 1523 (*Von ordenung gottis diensts*) he proposed a morning and an evening gathering of an hour each, with a Bible lesson, its exposition, psalms, responsories and antiphons. In 1526 (*Deutsche Messe*) he set out daily Matins and Vespers for "towns where there are schools", sung by the boys in Latin with a German lesson. This is the root of the Lutheran two-office pattern.
- **For chapters and convents: the full hours.** In the same year, 1523, the *Formula missae* allowed Matins of three lessons, the little hours, Vespers and Compline *de tempore*, "nothing but the words of divine Scripture", shortened at the bishop's discretion. Luther's advice for the Saxon visitation (quoted by Sehling) was to let "convents and chapters" keep "the canonical hours and lessons". The parish schools were to sing psalms, lessons, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum*, *Quicunque* and *Preces* morning and evening.
- **What was rejected** was "praying the seven hours" as a work "to earn grace" (*Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528).

**2. The full cursus survived in four kinds of place** (§10.4).

- **Collegiate churches and cathedrals**, in Latin, corrected *de tempore*:
  - Wittenberg castle 1525 and Altenburg 1533;
  - Ansbach 1531–1533 and Feuchtwangen 1563;
  - Goslar 1534;
  - Brandenburg 1540, under each diocese's Breviary "out of the former choir books";
  - Naumburg cathedral c. 1541;
  - Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and Heidelberg 1546;
  - Quakenbrück 1543 and Öhringen 1556;
  - Verden cathedral 1606, on weekends and feasts.
- **Bugenhagen's order for the remaining canons and monks.** The *Pia ordinatio* (Pomerania 1535) gives a full Latin cursus "according to the number of the hours hitherto customary". It passed into Denmark 1537, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543.
- **The women's convents.** Nimbschen 1529, Spandau 1541, the Calenberg convents 1542 and Frankenberg 1542 keep the hours, purged and shortened; at Frankenberg they are voluntary. The Lüneburg convents keep all seven (1555, 1574), with a corrected Breviary of their own, the *Emendatio Breviarii virginum* of 1555. Keppel in Nassau (1570) kept all seven hours in German.
- **Breslau** (a report of 1557), where the choralists still sang the hours of the Passion and of the Visitation on weekday mornings.

**3. Where the system was cut down** (§10.5).

- **In the parishes.** Most town orders follow Bugenhagen (Braunschweig 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania 1535): morning and evening offices of a quarter to half an hour, sung by the school. These fold Matins, Lauds, an octonary of the Prime psalm, Vespers and on feasts Compline into two services. "With such singing … it is enough for the parish churches."
- **Freed from the hours.** Some orders free chapters and convents from the hours altogether: Lippe 1538, Mecklenburg 1552, and the Mecklenburg convents 1572.
- **Decline.** The little hours lapsed (Feuchtwangen 1563). Saxony 1580 moved the weekday office from the Latin to the German school.

**4. Who prayed** (§10.6).

- **Schoolboys**, above all. Their office was a school exercise in the Bible and in public speaking.
- **Canons, vicars and altarists.** Their benefices were turned into an obligation to sing the hours *de tempore* daily, on pain of losing the fief: Stendal 1540, Cölln 1540, Salzwedel 1541.
- **Nuns** in the evangelical convents, often with their pastor.
- **The congregation**: on Saturdays, Sundays and feasts, and at German Vespers in the villages.
- **No breviary obligation on pastors.** The Merseburg synod of 1544 complains that pastors "discharged of the burden of the canonical hours" think they need "neither pray nor read". It exhorts them to daily prayer and the psalter. What the orders impose on pastors is the **public** office, held "even if no one came" (Pfalz-Neuburg 1576).
- **Students for the ministry.** The Württemberg cloister schools (1559) keep *preces* at four or five, a morning office and an evening office daily. The Tübingen stipendiaries pray the psalter in course morning and evening.

**5. The shape of the offices** (§10.7). The orders lay the liturgy out in detail.

- **Kept**: psalms with antiphons, lessons with responsories, pure hymns, the gospel canticles, *Te Deum*, *Quicunque*, Kyrie, Our Father, collect, *Benedicamus*.
- **Cut**: saints' suffrages, homilies and legends, the *preces*, the blessings before the lessons, and in Bugenhagen even *Deus in adiutorium*.
- **Intercession** (§10.7.5): the full *preces* were dropped (Wittenberg 1525, Ansbach 1533), but a short kneeling form of Kyrie, Our Father and *Ostende nobis* stayed in the Bugenhagen orders, and the Mecklenburg convents (1572) kept a full German set. Of the suffrages only those for peace, for sins and for the ruler stayed (Ansbach 1533, Transylvania 1547). Luther's Latin Litany took the place of the *Magnificat* at Saturday and eve Vespers (Pomerania 1535, 1542, 1569; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543), and the German Litany was sung after Prime or the *Benedictus* in the convents.
- **Added**: the psalter and the Bible in course, German lessons with Dietrich's summaries, German hymns, and sermons joined to Vespers.

**6. Language** (§10.8).

- **Latin** in the chapters and schools. At Wittenberg 1533 the scholars were "not to sing in German, save when the people sing with them".
- **German** in the convents (Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 "teutsch psallirn in gewonlichem ton"; Remse 1533; Keppel 1570; Mecklenburg 1572) and in the villages (Lippe 1571).
- **Both** in many towns and convents: a Latin lesson repeated in German, and Latin and German psalms in the same hour (Lüneburg 1574).

**7. Music** (§10.9).

- **The old chant kept.** The chapters sang from their medieval books. The old reciting and lesson tones are prescribed, including the prophecy cadence.
- **Reprinted.** From the 1540s the chant was purged and reprinted in the Lutheran antiphoners of **Spangenberg** (1545) and **Lossius** (1553/1561). Mecklenburg c. 1560, Oldenburg 1573, Lohr 1588 and Hof 1592 require them.
- **New pieces beside the old**:
  - German psalms sung to the old tones (Keppel 1570, from the Leipzig psalm-books);
  - Luther's German *Te Deum* and the German *Magnificat*;
  - polyphony at Vespers (Wittenberg 1533, Hof 1592);
  - organ alternation (Pomerania 1569, Oldenburg 1573).

**8. The catechism service** (§10.10). The Reformation added a service the old cursus did not have.

- **When.** Usually Sunday at noon or one o'clock (Mecklenburg 1552; Neckarbischofsheim 1560; Lippe 1571); sometimes early in the morning (Schwäbisch Hall 1543), inside Vespers (Naumburg 1537; Sangerhausen 1555; Thorn 1575), or as a recitation of the bare text in the morning service (Strasbourg 1548, Moderate Reformed, on the Interim; Palatinate 1563, Reformed; Saxony 1580).
- **How long.** Half an hour for the exposition or the examination (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Thorn 1575; Emden 1565 and Palatinate 1601, Reformed), an hour at most for the whole (Rostock c. 1560; Hohenlohe 1596).
- **The order.** Bell; a catechism hymn; the Our Father or a prayer; the text of the chief parts said by the pastor or recited by boys; one part expounded in course; the children examined by question and answer; a prayer, often for the children; hymn and blessing (Neckarbischofsheim 1560; Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Lippe 1571).
- **The Reformed form.** The Heidelberg Catechism was divided into Sundays; the youth recited the portion and the minister expounded the next, preaching it through yearly (Palatinate 1563). Hanau (1609, Reformed) examined the young in five classes, and kept the adults back behind shut doors.

**9. Ceremonial** (§10.11). The orders prescribe little for the body in the office.

- **Kneeling** is the one gesture they ask for: for the short *preces* after the gospel canticle (Bremen 1534), for *Veni sancte Spiritus* and *Da pacem* at Vespers (Pomerania 1569), for the closing collects (Stolberg-Königstein 1552), and at the opening of the Reformed morning and evening prayer (Palatinate 1563, Reformed, softened to "humble ourselves" in 1601).
- **The Litany** was sung by two to four boys kneeling before the altar, the choir and people answering (Schwarzburg 1574; Waldeck 1556; Marggrabowa 1581).
- **The choir** sang from stalls set facing, verse about verse (Mecklenburg convents 1572); the lesson was read from the pulpit, a lectern or before the altar (Coburg 1545; Herpf 1566).
- **The catechism service** has the most stage directions: the minister at the altar, the children brought into the middle of the church, boys and girls apart (Henneberg 1582), set in facing pairs or "as it were in two choirs" (Schönburg 1542; Strasbourg 1598), standing on stools to recite (Regensburg 1567), or kneeling with folded hands to pray (Heilbronn 1543).
- **Not found**: bows at the *Gloria Patri*, standing for the canticles, incense, hats, and the sign of the cross in choir. The cross survives only in the household blessing of the Small Catechism, defended in Kurland (1570) and struck from the draft in Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557).

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## 10.2 Scope, sources and cautions

**What was searched.** The `eko.db` database was searched for the office by name, in Latin, German and Low German spellings:

- *horae canonicae*, *horas canonicas*, *die sieben gezeiten*, *siben zeit*, *Tagzeiten*;
- *Mette*, *matutinae*, *laudes*, *prim*, *terz*, *sext*, *non*, *vesper*, *completorium*, *complet*;
- *Brevier*, *breviarium*, *psalmodia*;
- *precibus matutinis*, *preces vespertinae*, *frügebet*.

It was also searched for the people who prayed the office (*Stift*, *Domkapitel*, *Vicarien*, *Klosterjungfrauen*, *Schüler*, *Stipendiaten*), for obligations (*täglich … beten*, *Psalter*), and for the books and music (*Lossius*, *Spangenberg*, *Cantional*, *Noten*, *Ton*, *figuraliter*, *Orgel*). For the catechism service (§10.10) it was searched for *Katechismus*, *Kinderlehre*, *Kinderpredigt*, *Kinderfrag*, *examen catechismi* and *Fragstück* within a short distance of *singen*, *Gesang*, *Psalm*, *Gebet*, *Glocke*, *läuten*, *Uhr*, *Stunde* and *Segen*. The passages were then read in context.

**Related chapters.**

- Chapter 8 covers the German hymns sung at Vespers and Matins, and the *Benedicamus*.
- Chapter 4 covers the lesson tones and the prophecy cadence (§4.5.1) and the propers of the Mass.
- Chapter 5 covers the collects of the office, the Wittenberg collect series, and the Lenten *super populum* prayers kept at Lauds in Ansbach (§5.6.6).
- Chapter 16 covers the deacons, cantors and sextons who led the offices.
- Chapter 11 covers the Vespers sermon and the weekday sermons (§§11.4.1–11.4.3, 11.5.2).
- Chapter 13 covers the Litany (§13.22).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ at the office and the daily prayer bells (§§9.3, 9.5.3).
- Chapter 15 covers the schoolmaster's church duties and catechesis (§§15.9, 15.11).
- Chapter 12 covers the eves and first vespers of feasts (§12.4.6).

**Cautions.** Four things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Church orders are not breviaries.** Sehling prints the orders, not the books the choirs sang from. Where an order says "as hitherto" or "according to the Breviary", the detail is in books outside the corpus. Of the *Emendatio Breviarii* for the Lüneburg nuns, Sehling prints only the preface.
- **Silence is not absence.** Many town orders mention Matins and Vespers only in passing. Many chapters kept their hours without any order saying so. The corpus records reforms and disputes more often than settled custom.
- **The convents and chapters are under-represented.** Their own statutes and customaries are only partly in Sehling.
- **Dates.** Several texts survive in later copies or undated. Their dates are given as Sehling gives them, with his question marks.

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## 10.3 Luther's rulings, 1523 and 1526

### 10.3.1 *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523: a morning and an evening gathering

**Two daily gatherings.** Luther's first sketch of a reformed service, written for Leisnig, starts from the office and not from the Mass. Every day there should be two gatherings: one at four or five in the morning, and one at five or six in the evening. Each is to last an hour, with a lesson read in course from the Old Testament, its exposition, and then psalms, responsories and antiphons. **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 2–3):

> das man teglich des morgens eine stunde frue umb vier oder funfe zu samen keme und daselbs lesen liesse, es seien schuler oder priester, oder wer es sei, gleich wie man itzt noch die lection in der metten lieset. […] Wenn nu die lection und auslegung ein halb stund oder lenger geweret hat, sol man drauf in gemein got danken, loben und bitten umb frucht des worts etc. Dazu soll man brauchen der psalmen und etlicher guten responsoria, antiphon, kurz also, das es alles in einer stund ausgerichtet werde […]. Desselben gleichen an dem abent umb sechs oder funfe wider also zu samen.

that daily in the morning, early, at four or five, they should come together for an hour, and there let [a lesson] be read, be it scholars or priests or whosoever it be, even as the lesson is yet read at Matins. […] When now the lesson and the exposition have lasted half an hour or longer, then shall they together give thanks to God, praise him and pray for the fruit of the word,

etc. For this shall be used the psalms and some good responsories [and] antiphons, briefly, so that it all be finished within one hour [...]. Likewise in the evening at six or five come together again in the same manner.

**Who comes.** Luther did not expect the whole parish every day. Where it could not come, the office belonged to the priests and the schoolboys, above all to those who were to become preachers. They were to do it freely, not for reward. **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 3):

> Auch ob solchs tegliches gottis diensts vileicht nicht die ganze versamlunge gewarten kunde, sollen doch die priester und schuler und zuvor die ienigen, so man verhofft gute prediger und seelsorger aus zu werden, solchs thun. Und das man sie ermane, solchs frei, nicht aus zwang oder unlust, nicht umb lohn zeitlich noch ewig, sondern alleine gott zu ehren, den nehisten zu nutz zu thun.

And though perchance the whole congregation could not attend such daily service, yet shall the priests and scholars, and before all those of whom we hope that good preachers and pastors shall come, do it. And let them be exhorted to do it freely, not of constraint or with unwillingness, not for reward temporal or eternal, but only to the honour of God and the profit of their neighbour.

On Sundays, by contrast, "Mass and Vespers" were to be sung for the whole congregation, with a sermon at each (Sehling 1, p. 3). The proper texts of the office were to "lie still for a time, until they be swept", above all the antiphons, responsories and collects of the saints, "for there is grievous much filth therein" (Sehling 1, p. 3).

#### 10.3.2 *Formula missae*, 1523: the hours may stay, shortened

**Not two offices but all of them.** The *Formula missae* of the same year allows much more. On weekdays, once the Masses are abolished, Luther "sees nothing that cannot be borne". Matins of three lessons, the little hours, Vespers and Compline *de tempore* are "nothing but the words of divine Scripture". The bishop may shorten them. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 9):

> In reliquis diebus, quas ferias vocamus, nihil video, quod non ferri possit, modo missae abrogentur. Nam matutinae trium lectionum et horae, tum vesperae et completorium de tempore (exclusis sanctorum feriis) nihil sunt nisi scripturae divinae verba. Et pulchrum, imo necessarium est, pueros assuescere legendis et audiendis psalmis et lectionibus scripturarum sanctarum. Verum si quicquam hic novari debet, prolixitas mutari potest arbitrio episcopi, ut tres psalmi pro matutinis, tres pro vesperis cum uno vel duobus responsoriis absolvantur.

On the other days, which we call ferias, I see nothing that may not be borne, if only the Masses be abolished. For Matins of three lessons and the hours, and Vespers and Compline *de tempore* (the feasts of the saints being excluded), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture. And it is a fair thing, yea, a needful one, that the boys be accustomed to read and to hear the psalms and the lessons of the holy Scriptures. But if anything here ought to be changed, the length may be altered at the discretion of the bishop, so that three psalms for Matins [and] three for Vespers, with one or two responsories, be gone through.

**The psalter and the Bible in course.** The bishop is to choose the best responsories and antiphons and order them week by week, "so that the whole psalter, distributed in parts, remain in use, and the whole Scripture, divided into lessons, continue in the ears of the church". Daily lessons are to be added, one in the morning and one in the evening, "with explanation in the vernacular" (Sehling 1, p. 9).

#### 10.3.3 *Deutsche Messe*, 1526: a daily office for the schools

**Matins and Vespers in towns with schools.** The *Deutsche Messe* describes the weekday office as Luther wanted it "in towns where there are schools". In the morning the boys sing Latin psalms "as hitherto at Matins". Two or three boys read a chapter of the New Testament in Latin, one after another, and another boy reads it in German. A German lesson, a German hymn, the Our Father, a collect and the *Benedicamus* follow. Vespers is the same, with the Old Testament and the *Magnificat*. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 14):

> Fur die knaben und schuler in der biblia zu uben gehets also zu. Die wochen uber teglich fur der lection singen sie etliche psalmen latinisch, wie bis her zur metten gewonet, denn, wie-gesagt ist, wir wollen die jugent bei der latinschen sprachen in der biblia behalten und uben. [...] Desselbigen gleichen zur vesper singen sie etliche der vesper psalmen, wie sie bis her gesungen sind, auch latinsch mit einer antiphen, darauf einen hymnus, so er fur handen ist. [...] Darauf das

> magnificat zu latein mit einer antiphen oder lied. Darnach ein vater unser heimlich und die collecten mit dem Benedicamus. Das ist der gottis dienst teglich durch die wochen in stedten, da man schulen hat.

For the boys and scholars, to exercise them in the Bible, it goeth thus. Daily through the week, before the lesson, they sing certain psalms in Latin, as hitherto was customary at Matins; for, as hath been said, we will keep and exercise the youth in the Latin tongue in the Bible. […] In like manner at Vespers they sing certain of the Vesper psalms, as they have hitherto been sung, also in Latin with an antiphon, thereupon a hymn, if one be at hand. […] Thereupon the *Magnificat* in Latin, with an antiphon or a hymn. Thereafter an Our Father secretly, and the collect with the *Benedicamus*. That is the daily service through the week in towns where there are schools.

**What the "two offices" means.** In 1526 Luther gives only Matins and Vespers, and he gives them to the school, in Latin, with a German lesson for any laymen who are present. This is the origin of the two-office pattern of the Lutheran towns (§10.5.2). But he never forbade the other hours. The *Formula missae* had allowed them in 1523 (§10.3.2), and his advice for the Saxon visitation let the chapters and convents keep them (§10.4.1).

#### 10.3.4 The visitors of 1528: the hours as a work

**What was rejected.** The *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528 names "praying the seven hours" among the human ordinances made "to earn grace for our sins". In that sense they are "contrary to God" and may be dropped. **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 167):

> Die dritte ordnung sind gemacht, damit gnade zu erwerben für unsere sunde, als gesetzte fasten, am freitag nicht fleisch essen, die sieben gezeiten beten, und der gleichen. Solche meinung ist wider gott, darumb mag man auch solche gebot fallen lassen […].

The third [kind of] ordinances are made therewith to earn grace for our sins, as appointed fasts, eating no flesh on Friday, praying the seven hours, and the like. Such an opinion is against God; therefore one may also let such commandments fall […].

The text passed into Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 171). The objection is to the hours as a **meritorious obligation**, not to singing psalms at fixed times. Rothenburg 1559 draws the distinction plainly. Its council keeps the daily "singing, praying and reading in the church", with the Latin chants, "not as was once done in the papacy with the seven hours, … as a good work to atone and pay for sins", but because "not everyone can read the holy divine Scripture" (Sehling 11, p. 591).

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### 10.4 Where the full cursus survived

#### 10.4.1 Luther's advice: let the chapters and convents keep the hours

**For the Saxon visitation.** Sehling's introduction to Ernestine Saxony prints the deliberations drawn up for the first visitation. On the collegiate churches they propose to allow "the canonical hours on ferial days, but no Masses", and they quote Luther's own opinion. **Ernestine Saxony, deliberations for the visitation, quoted in Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 1, p. 38):

> Halt ichs fur gut, das man sie lasse (in clostern und stiften) horas canonicas und lectiones lesen, auf das sie nicht müssig und doch auch bei der schrift bleiben und sich uben. Allein das sie die messen nachlassen und was mer des gleichen greul ist. Wie es denn auch die visitatores angezeigt haben. Doctor Martinus Luthers meinung ist auch das man in pfarren morgens und abents die schuler lasse psalmen zween oder drei singen und lection lesen, item Benedictus, Magnificat, Te deum laudamus, Quicunque vult salvus esse, Preces, domit sie auch bei der schrift bleiben.

I hold it good that they be suffered (in convents and chapters) to read the canonical hours and lessons, that they be not idle, and yet abide by the Scripture and exercise themselves [therein]; only that they let the Masses go, and whatsoever more is such abomination. As the visitors also have shown. Doctor Martin Luther's opinion is also that in the parishes, morning and evening, the scholars be let sing two or three psalms and read a lesson, item the *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Te Deum laudamus*, *Quicunque vult salvus esse*, [and] the *Preces*, that they also abide by the Scripture.

The two levels are already here: the **full hours in chapters and convents**, and **two offices in the parishes**, sung by the school.

**The Wittenberg castle church, 1525.** The order for the All Saints' foundation in the castle at Wittenberg, where there was no parish, abolishes the Mass there but keeps a full Latin office. Vespers and Compline are joined: after the *Benedicamus* the psalm

*Qui habitat* and the *Nunc dimittis* are read without tone. Matins has a hymn verse, three psalms and three lessons from St Paul with three responsories, the *Te Deum*, and Lauds with the *Benedictus*. The little hours keep their structure, with a lesson from the Gospels in place of the chapter. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

> Ad primam, terciam, sextam, nonam. Sine deus in adiutorium. Ab hymnis illis consuetis incipiatur, post cantetur psalmus beati immaculati etc. et dividatur in has quattuor horas more solito cum antiphonis ex psalterio vel de tempore. Post antiphonam loco capituli consueti legatur lectio ex evangelistis incipiendo a Matthia, ita ut unum caput dividatur in quattuor partes secundum istas quattuor horas […].

At Prime, Terce, Sext [and] None. Without *Deus in adiutorium*. Let it begin with those customary hymns; after, let the psalm *Beati immaculati* etc. be sung, and let it be divided among these four hours in the accustomed manner, with antiphons from the psalter or *de tempore*. After the antiphon, in place of the customary chapter, let a lesson be read from the evangelists, beginning with Matthew, so that one chapter be divided into four parts according to these four hours […].

The order is explicit that all this is free: "we will that consciences be not bound by these things, as if by precept under necessity of salvation" (Sehling 1, p. 699).

#### 10.4.2 Collegiate churches and cathedrals

**Brandenburg-Ansbach, 1531–1533.** The Ansbach theologians' advice of 1531 lets the canons keep all seven hours, with only "the evil, offensive and uncertain" removed. It complains that the hours had been sung "with such haste that no choir heeded or waited for the other". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Gottesdienstmandat*, 1531** (Sehling 11, p. 312):

> Und bliben inen gleich wol ir horae, das ist tagzeit als mettin, prim, terz, sext, non, vesper und complet, wurde allain das bös, ergerlich und ungewis underlassen, welchs doch kain gutherziger gotzverstendiger strafen kunde. Nun ist auch meniglich bewust, das die horae von inen bisher ganz unordenlich und unfleißig gesungen sind worden mit solcher eil, das kain chor auf den andem gemerket und gewartet hat und oft der ander chor angefangen zu singen, ehe jener ausgesungen […].

And their hours would yet remain to them, that is, the times of day, as Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline; only the evil, offensive and uncertain would be left out, which no good-hearted man that understandeth God could blame. Now it is also known to everyone that the hours have hitherto been sung by them altogether disorderly and carelessly, with such haste that no choir heeded or waited for the other, and often the second choir began to sing before the first had finished […].

The *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften* of 1533 then goes through the Breviary hour by hour (Sehling 11, pp. 313–316):

- At Matins a whole chapter of the Old Testament is divided into the three lessons, so that the Old Testament is read through "in one or two years".
- Lauds is shortened to three psalms a day, each day with its own.
- Prime, Terce, Sext and None keep their hymns and psalms. At Terce a whole chapter of the Epistles replaces the chapter, beginning with Acts.
- The *preces* are dropped every day.
- Collects that sound of the saints or of merit are struck out one by one (see Chapter 5, §5.6.6).

**Brandenburg, 1540.** The electoral order of Joachim II keeps the whole Latin choir office in all chapters, convents and parish churches where it was customary, "according to each bishopric's Breviary". **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 71–72):

> Der chorgesang sol, wie bisanher, in allen stiften und klöstern, auch den pfarkirchen, wie. der gebreuchlich gewesen, latinisch gesungen und gelesen werden, zuvoran, so es de tempore ist, da sol nichts nachgelassen werden, es sei metten, prima, tertia, sexta, nona, vesper, complet oder was der mehr ist, ein iglichs, wie mans findet, nach seiner rubrica on alle leichtfertigkeit. Was aber de sanctis ist, sol von uns und unsern verordneten ubersehen und, wo es von nöten, corrigirt werden […]. Sonst sol offentlich in den kirchen gesungen und gelesen werden, beide frue und spat, nach eins jeden bistums brevir aus den vorigen sangbüchern […].

The choir chant shall, as hitherto, in all chapters and convents, and also in the parish churches where it hath been customary, be sung and read in Latin; above all, where it is *de tempore*, nothing shall be omitted, be it Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers, Compline or whatever more there is, each as it is found, according to its rubric, without any lightness. But what is *de sanctis* shall be looked over by us and those we appoint, and where needful corrected […]. Otherwise shall be sung and read publicly in the churches, both early and late, according to each bishopric's Breviary, out of the former choir books […].

**Naumburg cathedral, c. 1541–1543.** The cathedral chapter sent the elector an account of its daily worship. It keeps every hour and joins them to the evangelical preaching. **Naumburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche*, 1543 (1541?), printed in Sehling's supplement** (Sehling 2, p. 596):

> Morgens in precibus matutinis werden gehalten drei psalm, drei lectiones mit responsoriis de tempore und von den festen, welcher historien in der heiligen schrift gegruendet. Unter dem Te deum laudamus geschiecht ein sonderlicher puels zu der teuzschen lection. Nach deme Te deum laudamus werden gehalten psalmi de laudibus mit dem cantico Zacharie, und concludirt mit der collecten de tempore die metten. Darauf wirt gelesen auf teuzschs ein capitel aus der biblien mit einem summario und das volk vormanet zum gebete, und mit einem deuzschen gesinge und collecten beschlossen. Umb die sechste stunde werden die prime und terz gehalten de tempore […]. Umb die neunde stunde werden gehalten sext und nona. Vespertine preces und completorium werden zwischen zweien und dreien gehalten.

In the morning, in the morning prayers, are kept three psalms [and] three lessons, with responsories *de tempore* and of the feasts whose histories are grounded in holy Scripture. During the *Te Deum laudamus* a special bell is rung for the German lesson. After the *Te Deum laudamus* are kept the psalms of Lauds with the Canticle of Zachary, and Matins is concluded with the collect *de tempore*. Thereupon a chapter out of the Bible is read in German with a summary, and the people are exhorted to prayer, and it is concluded with a German hymn and collects. About the sixth hour Prime and Terce are kept *de tempore* […]. About the ninth hour are kept Sext and None. The evening prayers and Compline are kept between two and three.

On Sundays and feasts "the hours, as the morning prayers, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, are kept in order one after another", and the bell for the sermon and the Lord's Supper is rung under None (Sehling 2, p. 596).

**Other chapters.** The full Latin cursus is kept, corrected *de tempore*, in:

- **Altenburg castle chapter, 1533**: "the seven hours … and briefly, with only one nocturn", so that the canons "go not altogether idle"; the "pure new Litany" replaces the *preces* (Sehling 1, p. 515).
- **Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534**: Sehling's introduction notes that Widensee "keeps the outward form of the office": the canonical hours stay in the choir, the length is not reduced, and Latin is kept. Only the Lord's Supper is in German (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 199).
- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: where chapters, convents and parishes sing "some or all of the canonical hours, daily or only on certain feasts", they shall continue (Sehling 13, p. 77). The Heidelberg chapter of the Holy Spirit followed the same text in 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 91).
- **Quakenbrück, 1543**: Hermann Bonnus's "daily exercise in the Scriptures and in singing psalms, for collegiate churches where the Gospel is preached" (Sehling 7/1, p. 229; §10.6.2).
- **Öhringen 1556**: "the old and young persons of the chapter shall sing them daily in order" (Sehling 15, p. 102).
- **Verden cathedral, 1606**: Matins and Vespers on Saturdays, Sundays and feasts, "as the old order bringeth with it", with the pure antiphons, psalms, responsories and hymns, ending "with the *Benedicamus* or Compline" (Sehling 7/1, p. 153).

### 10.4.3 Bugenhagen's order for the remaining canons and monks

**A complete Latin cursus.** Bugenhagen's *Pia ordinatio* (Pomerania 1535) has a full order of hours "according to the number of the hours hitherto customary". It was made for the monks who could not leave and for "the canons, who are now of no use to the Church of Christ". It passed into the Danish order of 1537, the Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 (in Low German) and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 23, p. 142; 6/1, p. 81). **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 349):

> Eadem plane dicimus de canonicis, qui nullo iam usui sunt ecclesiae Christi. Possunt et ipsi residui, si non aliis offitiis necessariis sunt commodi, ita hisce scripturae exercitiis cantando pro suo tempore exerceri. Sic vero potest ordinari cantus cum lectionibus (si ita placet) secundum numerum horarum hactenus consuetarum: […]

The same we say plainly of the canons, who are now of no use to the Church of Christ. They also that remain, if they be not fit for other necessary offices, may thus be exercised in these exercises of Scripture by singing, for their time. And thus may the chant with the lessons be ordered (if it so please), according to the number of the hours hitherto customary: […]

The order then gives Matins (with Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext, None and Vespers, and Compline recited "with a low voice without any tone" (§10.7.1). Its purpose is stated at the end: the psalms are to run on from day to day, and the whole Bible is to be read "twice or more in a year", for the consolation of those "who, hindered by age or otherwise, cannot now take up a better condition, until they render their spirit to God" (Sehling 4, p. 350).

#### 10.4.4 The women's convents

**The convents kept the hours longest.** Most surviving women's houses became evangelical convents, and most of their orders keep the hours, purged and shortened:

- **Nimbschen, 1529** (Katharina von Bora's former convent): on feasts "they shall sing Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext etc." (Sehling 1, p. 617).
- **The Leipzig friaries, 1539**: the remaining friars may keep the canonical hours *de tempore* "among themselves, yet without bells and with the church doors locked, in quiet" (Sehling 1, p. 589). The *Gemeines Fürhalten* of the same visitation allows the religious, "until further provision", to "read or sing the seven hours, yet only *de tempore* and what is agreeable to God's word, … as a church exercise" (Sehling 1, p. 590).
- **Spandau, 1541**: the nuns' Breviary was examined by the visitors and corrected. They keep Matins (three psalms, a chapter divided into three lessons with responsories, the *Te Deum* and Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext and None, and between Prime and Terce one of them reads an article of the church order or the catechism aloud in the refectory (Sehling 3, p. 305).
- **The Calenberg convents, 1542**: Lauds only on Sundays and feasts; "Prima, tertia, sexta, nona … with the customary psalms, antiphons and collects"; Vespers and Compline "with the customary psalms, antiphons, hymns" (Sehling 6/2, p. 851).
- **Frankenberg at Goslar, 1542**: a Latin order in place of the hours, which the nuns "shall do freely and not under constraint", without sin "if they keep them less exactly or even leave them off altogether" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 277).
- **The Lüneburg convents, 1555**: all seven hours, with a corrected Breviary (below).
- **Keppel in Nassau, 1570**: all seven hours, in German (§10.8.2).

**Lüneburg, 1555.** The *Reformatio coenobiorum* of 1555 orders the nuns of the Lüneburg convents to meet daily for all seven hours, with the chants and lessons corrected. **Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis*, 1555** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 611–612):

> Zum dritten sollen die klosterjungfrauen Gott mit lesen und singen loben und ehren und vor die zeitliche und ewige wolfart bitten, und derwegen soilen sie alle tage etliche zeit in der kirchen zusamenkommen und in den metten, prim, terz, sext, non, vesper und complet die christliche gesenge und lectiones de tempore und von den hohen festen, auch de sanctis, doch mit der christlichen correction und veranderung, wie die sonderlich beschrieben und verordenet sein, singen und lesen.

Thirdly, the convent virgins shall praise and honour God with reading and singing, and pray for the temporal and eternal welfare; and therefore they shall every day for some time come together in the church, and in Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline sing and read the Christian chants and lessons *de tempore* and of the high feasts, and also *de sanctis*, yet with the Christian correction and alteration, as the same are specially written down and ordained.

The "correction" is the *Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti in ducatu Luneburgensi* of the same year, a revised Benedictine Breviary for the nuns. It marks what may be "read and sung piously" and what may be "omitted without any scruple of conscience" (Sehling 6/1, p. 624).

**Breslau, 1557.** A report of 1557 on the order of the Breslau churches says that in the Lutheran city the choralists still sang Little Hours of the medieval type every weekday morning: "the hours of the Passion of the Lord", and on Fridays "the hours of the Visitation of the Blessed Virgin Mary", before the Mass (Sehling 3, p. 405).

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## 10.5 Where the system was cut down

### 10.5.1 The case against the hours

**"Murmurings".** The sharpest words come from Bugenhagen's *Pia ordinatio*. The monks are to be taught that Christ alone is their righteousness, and that "those murmurings of the canonical hours, and long and feigned prayers, are wearyings of the body and vexations of the conscience". **Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 345):

> murmura vero illa horarum canonicarum et lougas simulatasque preces esse fatigationes corporum et vexationes conscientiarum. Deinde nihil canant aut legant publice, quod non sit ex sacra acceptum scriptura, id est ex veteri et novo testamento [...].

but that those murmurings of the canonical hours, and long and feigned prayers, are wearyings of the body and vexations of the conscience. Further, that they sing or read nothing publicly that is not taken from holy Scripture, that is, from the Old and New Testament [...].

Schleswig-Holstein 1542 has the same in Low German: "dat Murrent der tide, dat men nömet Horas Canonicas" (Sehling 23, p. 131). Yet the same order goes on to give the full cursus (§10.4.3). The objection is to the hours as a burden on the conscience, not to the psalms sung in course.

**What "canonical hours" ought to mean.** The Hamburg order of 1529 argues that the hours took their name from the reading of canonical Scripture. Rightly understood, they would be hours of lectures on the Bible, "as now in the high school at Wittenberg". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 493):

> So hefft me etlike bestemmede stunden des dages gehat, dar inne me gelesen und gehöret hefft scripturam canonicam, alse nu in der hogen schole tho Wittenberch. Up de stunde hefft canonicus Petrus gelesen canonicam scripturam, up eine andere stunde canonicus Joannes etc., dar van sint solcke bestemmede stunden hore canonice genömet. In welcken so to lesende und scrift to utleggende, dat me gelerde pastores unde evangelistas mochte van den tohörers maken, were wol recht horas canonicas lesen.

So there were certain appointed hours of the day, wherein canonical Scripture was read and heard, as now in the high school at Wittenberg. At one hour the canon Peter read the canonical Scripture, at another hour the canon John, etc.; from this such appointed hours are named *horae canonicae*. In these so to read and to expound Scripture, that learned pastors and evangelists might be made of the hearers, were indeed rightly to read the canonical hours.

Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 repeats the etymology: "these are also *horae canonicae*, the hours in which canonical Scripture is read and treated" (Sehling 6/1, p. 49).

**"Not burdened with the canonical hours".** Several territorial orders free the chapters and convents from the hours altogether, and put preaching in their place. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 196):

> sollen auch den stiften und klöstern ernstlich befehlen, das sie sich den pfarkirchen gleichformig machen, mit predigen, mit der communio und mit andern christlichen ceremonien, und mit abthuung der misbreuch, der opfermess, der heiligen anrufung, gelübden und kappen etc. Sollen auch nicht mit den horis canonicis beladen sein.

[They] shall also earnestly command the chapters and convents that they make themselves conformable to the parish churches, with preaching, with the communion and with other Christian ceremonies, and with the putting away of the abuses, the sacrificial Mass, the invocation of the saints, vows and cowls, etc. They shall also not be burdened with the canonical hours.

The Lippe order of 1538 has the same words in Low German: "Schollen oick nicht mit den horis canonicis beladen syn" (Sehling 21, p. 343). The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 frees the nuns too: "none of the virgins shall be burdened with the canonical hours *de tempore*", for true prayer "is not bound to certain times and places" and does not please God "for the sake of the work, especially when it is babbled without understanding in the Latin unknown tongue" (Sehling 5, p. 257). In its place it sets a daily German office of its own (§10.8.2).

**Hours displaced by preaching.** Where the old clergy kept their hours beside the evangelical preachers, the orders protect the sermon:

- **Herford 1532**: while there is preaching, "no priests shall sing or read their hours in any church" (Sehling 21, p. 170).

- **Zwickau 1545**: "the singing of the hours in the hospital of St Margaret shall be abolished". The hospital preacher is instead to sing "a psalm or spiritual song" daily with the poor and read them a lesson from the Old or New Testament (Sehling 1, p. 725).

#### 10.5.2 Two offices, sung by the school

**Bugenhagen's argument.** The commonest Lutheran form is Luther's 1526 pattern: Matins and Vespers, sung daily by the Latin school. Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order of 1528 gives the reason in terms that recur at Hamburg 1529 and Lübeck 1531. The old school custom of singing psalms, antiphons and responsories helped learned men "to learning and to memory". It had been spoiled only where "the canonical hours and other things without end" were sung and left to "drunken choirboys".
**Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 399):

> Vele, de gelert synt, möten bekennen, dat id en tor lere unde tor memorie geholpen hefft, dat se in der jöget mosten singen psalme unde etlike antiphen unde responsoria etc., welk ock plach mit guder meticheit gewönlick syn in kleynen steden unde ock in groten, alse noch, dar me nicht singet horas canonicas unde andere dink, des neyn ende is, dat ock vordretlick is geworden den presteren unde bevalen den drunkenen chorschöleren. Darumme wille wy sulke nutticheit unsen kynderen ock hebben, dat se avent unde morgen singen unde lesen alle dage, welk me plecht to nömen vesper unde metten.

Many that are learned must confess that it hath helped them to learning and to memory that in their youth they had to sing psalms and certain antiphons and responsories etc., which also was wont to be customary with good measure in small towns and also in great ones (as it yet is where they sing not the canonical hours and other things whereof there is no end), which also became irksome to the priests, and [was] committed to the drunken choirboys. Therefore we will have such profit for our children also, that they sing and read evening and morning every day, which is wont to be named Vespers and Matins.

**Enough for a parish church.** Bugenhagen's Pomeranian order of 1535 says the same in its own terms. The boys sing Latin psalms and lessons with the *Benedictus* in the morning, and psalms, lessons, a hymn and the *Magnificat* in the afternoon, each for no more than a quarter of an hour. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 342):

> An solckeme singende unde ceremonien is idt genoch vor de parrekercken, dat me nene horas canonicos (!) eder andere meer bedarf. Me schal de kindere des werkeldages in der kercken nicht över ein verndel van der stunde laten singen, dat se sick alse mit luste gewonnen to der hiligen schrift, unde ljkewol dar mede nicht vorsümet werden in erer scholekunst […].

With such singing and ceremonies it is enough for the parish churches, so that no canonical hours (!) or anything more be needed. On working days the children shall not be let sing in the church above a quarter of an hour, that they so with delight grow used to holy Scripture, and yet be not hindered thereby in their school learning […].

**The towns.** Matins and Vespers in this form, or Saturday and Sunday Vespers with Sunday Matins, are the rule in the town orders:

- Wittenberg 1533 (Sehling 1, pp. 701–705);
- Saxony 1539 and 1580 (Sehling 1, pp. 564, 368);
- Senftenberg 1555 (Sehling 1, pp. 671–672);
- Prussia 1568 (Sehling 4, pp. 74–75);
- Hoya 1581, Lüneburg 1575, Pomerania 1569 (§10.7.2).

Senftenberg is typical of a small electoral town. **Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg*, 1555** (Sehling 1, pp. 671–672):

> Alle sontage, hohe festa und feiertage sol den morgen fru hora 5 wie gewonlich metten mit dem invitatorio, psalmodia, lection des evangelii, teutsch respons. et benedicamus beschlossen werden. […] Es sol auch in der wochen auf die werkeltage alle tage den morgen umb 7 hora eine metten mit psalmodi, teutscher lection aus dem alten testament sampt dem benedictus collecten und benedicamus, nachmittage aber umb 2 hora eine vesper mit ihrer psalmodi, lection aus dem neuen testa

All Sundays, high feasts and holy days, in the morning early at the fifth hour, Matins shall be held as is customary, with the invitatory, psalmody, the lesson of the Gospel, a German responsory, and concluded with the *Benedicamus*. […] Also in the week on the working days, every day in the morning about the seventh hour, [there shall be] a Matins with psalmody, a German lesson out of the Old Testament, together with the *Benedictus*, collects and *Benedicamus*; and in the afternoon about the second hour a Vespers with its psalmody, a lesson out of the New Testa[ment] […]

#### 10.5.3 Decline and transfer

**Moved from the Latin school to the German school.** By 1580 the Saxon visitors thought the daily office kept the Latin scholars from their studies. In the great towns, on days without a sermon, it was handed to the **German school** and reduced to a psalm, a chapter and a collect. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 370):

> Wo auch in grossen stedten gebreuchlich, das man teglich metten und vesper auf die tage, da man nicht prediget, zuhalten pfleget, dardurch die schüler in der lateinischen schulen an ihrem studiren nicht wenig verseumet werden, soll hinfort, soviel das gesang belanget, dasselbige durch die deutschen schulen versehen, und allezeit ein psalm vor und einer nach gesungen, darzwischen aber ein capitel aus der bibel, sampt dem summario durch den diaconum gelesen, und mit den gewönlichen collecten beschlossen werden.

Where also in great towns it is the custom to keep Matins and Vespers daily on the days when there is no preaching, whereby the scholars in the Latin schools are not a little hindered in their studies, it shall henceforth, so far as the singing is concerned, be provided by the German schools; and always a psalm shall be sung before and one after, but between them a chapter out of the Bible, together with the summary, read by the deacon, and concluded with the customary collects.

**The little hours fall away.** At Feuchtwangen in 1563 the chapter still sang Matins and Lauds daily, but Prime, Terce, Sext and None had lapsed for some years. They clashed with the parish sermon nearby, there were no scholars to sing, and "many spoke mockingly" of them. By then the four little hours were sung in rotation, one a day. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, Feuchtwangen, 1563** (Sehling 11, p. 402):

> und der communicanten, die in stift gehörig, wenig, darzue bis anher von solchem singen und lesen von vilen schimpflich geredet und gehalten worden, sein solche horae und communion der ursachen halben und nit aus faul- oder treghait etzliche jar her underlassen und nicht gehalten worden.

and the communicants that belong to the chapter [being] few, and moreover, many having hitherto spoken and held mockingly of such singing and reading, such hours and communion have for these causes, and not out of sloth or idleness, for some years been left off and not kept.

**Other signs.**

- **Torgau 1529**: the schoolmasters complained that at seven they had to sing "private hours" in the church while the school waited. The visitors gave the hours to the altarists, though the masters were to keep the stipend and help when they could (Sehling 1, p. 677).
- **The Schönburg lordships**: the "hour-priests" of the castle are to sing the hours daily "slowly and distinctly", though the reformer "would rather advise" one or two sermons in the castle "instead of such hours, since no one or very few are bettered by them". The Matins he then gives begins with "*Deus in adjutorium* in Latin" and has "*Venite*, 4 psalms in German" (Sehling 2, p. 170).
- **Mülhausen 1524** (Reformed): Sehling's introduction notes that the council left the singing of Matins, Terce and Sext to the chaplains' discretion but kept None and Vespers (Sehling 20/2, p. 163).

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## 10.6 Who prayed the offices, and under what obligation

#### 10.6.1 The schoolboys

**The office as school exercise.** In the parishes the office belonged to the Latin school. The cantor led the boys in the choir, and the boys read the lessons. The orders give two reasons, practice in the Bible and practice in public speaking. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 75):

> Darauf soll ein knabe aus der bibel latine in usitato tono eine lectionem lesen, also lectio Jesaiae etc. prophetae, capite etc., und soll darauf, was solcher knabe latine gelesen, ein anderer deutsch lesen fur dem chor schlecht sine tono. Solche lectiones dienen dazu, dass die liebe jugend ein wenig den text der bibel fasse, denn es ja so gering nimmermehr abgehet, die liebe kinder behalten etwas davon. So ist es ihnen auch darzu nütze, das sie lernen und gewohnen in der kirchen nach ihrem berufe fur dem volke zu reden, und dasjenige, worzu sie erfordert werden, one furcht auszurichten.

Thereupon shall a boy read a lesson out of the Bible in Latin in the customary tone, thus: "Lectio Isaiae prophetae, capite" etc.; and thereupon what the boy hath read in Latin shall another read in German before the choir, plainly, without tone. Such lessons serve thereto, that the dear youth may grasp a little of the text of the Bible; for it never goeth off so slightly but the dear children retain something of it. So is it also profitable to them that they learn and grow used to speak in the church before the people, according to their calling, and to perform without fear that whereunto they are required.

The school's burden was weighed against its studies:

- At Wittenberg in 1533, if the boys had sung the Mass in the morning, "they shall sing no Vespers that day, that they be not too much hindered in their studies" (Sehling 1, p. 705).
- Saxony 1580 moved the weekday office from the Latin to the German school for the same reason (§10.5.3).

### 10.6.2 Canons, vicars and altarists: an obligation tied to the benefice

**Hours instead of Masses.** Where the endowed Masses fell away but the incomes remained, the orders turned the holders of benefices into a choir for the hours. At Stendal in 1540 the vicars keep their incomes on condition that they sing the hours daily and hear the sermons and theology lectures. **Stendal, *Verordnung für die übrigen Kirchen*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 310):

> Weil denn die privatmessen, darauf die vicarien instituirt gewesen, des offnen erkannten missbrauchs halben abgangen und dennoch den vicarien ihre einkommen davon bleiben, sollen sie hinfort, jede in ihren pfarrkirchen, täglich horas canonicas de tempore singen und in die predigt mit fleiss gehen, desgleichen auch die lectiones in theologia, die der superintendent allhier thun wird, visitiren. Dagegen sollen sie alle horas und memorien, die sie zuvor gesungen und gehalten, gänzlich fallen lassen.

Since now the private Masses, to which the vicars were instituted, have ceased by reason of their open and acknowledged abuse, and yet their incomes from them remain to the vicars, they shall henceforth, each in their parish churches, sing the canonical hours *de tempore* daily, and go diligently to the sermon, and likewise attend the lectures in theology which the superintendent here shall give. On the other hand they shall let fall altogether all hours and memorials which they formerly sang and kept.

The Brandenburg town orders enforce this obligation with the loss of the benefice:

- **Cölln on the Spree, 1540**: every priest holding a benefice in the two churches is to sing the canonical hours *de tempore* daily in St Nicholas; "whatever priest refuseth this shall be deprived of his fief" (Sehling 3, p. 156).
- **Salzwedel, 1541**: all vicars and commendists resident in the town are to sing the hours daily "every morning, winter and summer, at six o'clock", on pain of losing the vicarage (Sehling 3, p. 267).

**Bonnus at Quakenbrück, 1543.** Hermann Bonnus gives two reasons for keeping the daily office in the collegiate churches: the holders of prebends, "that they live not wholly in idleness", and the scholars. **Stift Osnabrück, *Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 229):

> Utile et necessarium in primis est, retinere in collegiatis ecclesiis exercitium sacrae scripturae et psalmorum: idque propter personas religiosas, quae possident praebendas et beneficia ecclesiastica, ne prorsus in otio vivant, deinde etiam propter scholasticos, quos plurimum conducit exercere diligenter in legendis et cantandis psalmis et lectionibus sacris quotidie.

It is above all useful and needful to retain in the collegiate churches the exercise of holy Scripture and of the psalms: and that for the sake of the religious persons who possess prebends and ecclesiastical benefices, that they live not wholly in idleness; and then also for the sake of the scholars, whom it greatly profiteth to be diligently exercised daily in reading and singing the psalms and the holy lessons.

### 10.6.3 The convents and their pastors

**Daily office with the pastor.** In the evangelical convents the pastor often led the office. At the Cistercian convent of Leeden in Tecklenburg (1585) the conventuals and the abbess are to meet "with their pastor every day in the morning at seven o'clock in the convent church". There they say the morning prayer, sing a psalm, and hear a chapter of the Bible read and briefly expounded by the pastor (Sehling 22, p. 247). At Keppel (1570) the preacher is to teach the nuns the melodies of the German psalms (§10.9.2).

### 10.6.4 The congregation

**Sunday and feast-day offices for all.** Luther meant the weekday office for "the smaller crowd" and the Sunday Mass and Vespers for "the whole congregation" (§10.3.1). The orders follow this:

- Saturday and Sunday Vespers, Sunday Matins and festal Matins are public services, with sermon or catechism.
- On weekdays the offices are attended by whoever comes. At Naumburg the people sing a psalm with the scholars, "one verse after the other" (Sehling 2, p. 596).
- Saturday Vespers is also the hour of confession for those who will communicate. Kurland 1570 explains Saturday Vespers as the time when servants and labourers are let off work "to prepare and make themselves ready" (Sehling 5, p. 83).

**Village Vespers in German.** In the villages there was no Latin school, and the orders give a German Vespers led by the pastor and the sexton. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 395):

> Erstlich soll die Vesper umb zween schlegen alle Son- und Festabendt angefangen werden. Und sol der Pfarrherr neben seinem Küster und den Knaben, so der Custos zu leren bey sich hat, und jetzt auff den Dörffern gewöntlich, einen teutschen Psalm singen, Drauff den Hymnum nach gelegenheit der Sontage und Feste, Darnach den Lobgesang der Jungfrawen Marien und die Collecten oder Gebett neben dem Benedicamus. Es sol aber alles Teutsch auff den Dörffern gesungen werden, damit die einfeltige, ungeschickte Schüler der Küster und Beichtkinder auff dem Lande der Gottseligen Psalmen gewohnen […].

First, Vespers shall be begun at two o'clock on every Sunday and feast eve. And the pastor, together with his sexton and the boys whom the sexton hath with him to teach (as is now customary in the villages), shall sing a German psalm; thereupon the hymn according to the occasion of the Sundays and feasts; thereafter the Song of the Virgin Mary, and the collect or prayer, with the *Benedicamus*. But all shall be sung in German in the villages, that the simple, unskilled scholars of the sexton and the penitents in the country may grow used to the godly psalms […].

Other village provisions:

- **Prussia 1568**: "in small parishes and villages", one or two German psalms and a short catechism instruction at Vespers (Sehling 4, p. 75).
- **Lippe 1571 and Oldenburg 1573**: since there can be no Matins in the villages in winter, the pastors are to gather the people early in the morning in summer, from Easter to Michaelmas (Sehling 21, p. 396; 7/2.1, p. 1111).
- **Schwäbisch Hall 1543**: village Vespers "with a short sermon and psalms" is left to each pastor's discretion (Sehling 17/1, p. 170).

### 10.6.5 The pastors

**No breviary obligation.** No Lutheran order in the corpus binds a pastor to recite the hours privately. The *Unterricht* of 1528 treats "praying the seven hours" as a human ordinance that binds no conscience (§10.3.4).

**An exhortation instead.** The Merseburg synodal decree of 1544 noticed the result. Some pastors, "now that they are discharged of the burden of the canonical hours, think they need neither pray nor read any more". It answers with an exhortation, not a rule: daily prayer and use of the psalter. **Merseburg, synodal decree, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 13):

> und dieweil sie nun der burde der horarum canonicarum entlediget, meinen, sie dürfen furder wider beten noch lesen, gehen die ganze woche mussig, ader warten der narung […]. Darumb sollen die pfarher ernstlich zum vleissigen teglichen gebet erinnert sein, dan so sie solches vorseumen, werden sie dem teufel raum lassen, und gottes und der obrickeit straf nicht empflihen. In sonderheit aber wollen sie sich im heiligen psalter vleissig uben, und den so vorechtlichen nicht liegen lassen.

and since they are now discharged of the burden of the canonical hours, they think they need from henceforth neither pray nor read; they go idle the whole week, or wait upon their livelihood […]. Therefore the pastors shall be earnestly admonished to diligent daily prayer; for if they neglect the same, they will give place to the devil, and not escape the punishment of God and of the magistrate. But especially let them exercise themselves diligently in the holy psalter, and not let it lie so despised.

**The pastor's public duty.** What the orders do impose on pastors is the **public** office:

- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1576**: Saturday and feast-eve Vespers must be held in towns, markets and villages. "In case that no one at all came into the church", the pastor shall still have the bell rung and read a chapter of the Bible with its summary (Sehling 13, p. 178). The order adds that this keeps him at home on Saturday evening, preparing his sermon.
- **Saxony 1580**: the deacons and preachers are to be present at "the daily early prayer" (*teglichen frügebet*) as well as the sermons (Sehling 1, p. 422).
- **Hohenlohe 1588**: in time of war the countess ordered a daily prayer service (*das alltägliche Gebet*) in every parish, and the pastors were to urge their people to attend (Sehling 15, pp. 538–550).

#### 10.6.6 Students and future pastors

**The Württemberg cloister schools, 1559.** The Great Church Order of Württemberg turned the monasteries into schools for future ministers. Their day begins at four or five with *preces*: a psalm read in course by one of the students, and a Latin prayer for the Church, the emperor, the duke, the prelate and their studies. **Württemberg, *Ordnung der Klosterschulen*, 1559** (Sehling 16, pp. 365–366):

> das alle Tag, es seien Feyer- oder Wercktag, vor Mittag, morgendts im Winter umb fünffe, im Sommer aber nach vier Uhrn, ungefahrlich, so sie durch des Klosters geleutte Glocken auffgemundert, Preces samentlich gehalten, und einer auß den Studiosen mit erhebter Stimm verstentlich einen Psalmen ex ordine, wie es die Ordnung geben würdt, lese. […] Hernach an einem jettlichen Wercktag alle Morgen, zu Sommers zeitten nach acht, Wintters zeit umb neun Uhr […], zween oder drey Psalmos, nach dem sie lang oder kurtz seind, mit den gewonlichen Christlichen Antiphonen de Tempore singen und darauff ein gantz Capitel auß dem alten Testament von anfang der Bibel nach seiner Ordnung verlesen und dasselbig mit dem Benedictus oder Symbolo Athanasii, alternis ein tag umb den andern, auch gewonlichen Christlichen Antiphonen de Tempore und Collect beschliessen.

that every day, be it holy day or working day, before noon, in the morning in winter at five, but in summer after four o'clock or thereabouts, when they are roused by the convent's ringing bells, they hold *preces* together, and one of the students read with raised voice, distinctly, a psalm in order, as the order shall give it. […] Thereafter on every working day, every morning, in summer after eight, in winter at nine o'clock […], [they shall] sing two or three psalms, according as they be long or short, with the customary Christian antiphons *de tempore*, and thereupon read a whole chapter out of the Old Testament in its order from the beginning of the Bible, and conclude the same with the *Benedictus* or the Athanasian Creed, alternately one day after the other, also with the customary Christian antiphons *de tempore* and a collect.

In the afternoon a chapter of the New Testament is read, with the *Magnificat* or the *Nunc dimittis* alternately (Sehling 16, p. 366). One student is appointed each week as *hebdomadarius* for the *preces* and another for the lessons (Sehling 16, p. 367).

**The Tübingen Stipendium, 1559.** The ducal stipendiaries at Tübingen, the theology students who were to become Württemberg's pastors, are bound by their statutes to pray "every day, morning and evening", reciting the psalms "one or two at a time until they are finished" and then a set prayer (Sehling 17/1, p. 562). The medieval obligation of the clergy to the psalter survives here as a rule of the seminary.

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## 10.7 The shape of the reformed offices

#### 10.7.1 What was kept, cut and added

**The orders set out the liturgy.** Many orders give the office in detail, hour by hour: Wittenberg 1525, Braunschweig 1528, Ansbach 1533, Goslar 1534, Pomerania 1535, Spandau 1541, Bonnus 1543, Württemberg 1559, Keppel 1570, Lüneburg 1574. Their common features are these.

**Kept:**

- the **psalms** with their **antiphons**, sung in two choirs "verse by verse";
- the **lessons**, with **responsories** after them at Matins;
- the **office hymns**, if "pure";
- the **gospel canticles**: *Benedictus* at the morning office, *Magnificat* at Vespers, *Nunc dimittis* at Compline;
- the ***Te Deum*** at Sunday and festal Matins;
- the **Athanasian Creed** at Sunday Prime (Ansbach 1533, Goslar 1534, Pomerania 1535);
- the **Kyrie**, **Our Father**, the versicle *Ostende nobis*, the **collect** *de tempore* and the ***Benedicamus***;
- the **invitatory** and *Venite* at Matins (Senftenberg 1555, Frankenberg 1542, Keppel 1570).

**Cut:**

- everything *de sanctis* that asks for the saints' intercession, with the suffrages and the Marian antiphons;
- the **homilies and legends** at Matins, replaced by Scripture;
- the **preces**, which are dropped (Wittenberg 1525, Ansbach 1533) or replaced by the Litany (Altenburg 1533), though a short form survived (§10.7.5);
- the blessings before the lessons, ***Jube, domne, benedicere*** and ***Tu autem, Domine*** (Braunschweig 1528, Pomerania 1535, Frankenberg 1542);
- in Bugenhagen's orders, even the opening ***Deus in adiutorium*** and ***Domine, labia mea*** (Wittenberg 1525, Pomerania 1535, Bonnus 1543). Bugenhagen explains in a note added in the Danish version. He does not forbid the words ("who would forbid it?"), but they are prayed "against the persecutors of the Church", and those are now the very men "who say *Deus in adiutorium* so many times a day" (Sehling 4, p. 350, n. 1);
- the **Office of the Dead** and vigils (Pomerania 1535).

**Shortened:**

- **three psalms** for Matins and three for Vespers (Luther 1523; Bugenhagen; Spandau 1541);
- **one nocturn** instead of three (Altenburg 1533; Lüneburg 1574);
- the little hours run together (Naumburg: Prime with Terce, Sext with None) or **rotated** one a day (Feuchtwangen 1563);
- Vespers and Compline **joined**, with Compline reduced to *Qui habitat* and the *Nunc dimittis* read without tone (Wittenberg 1525, Pomerania 1535, Braunschweig 1528).

**Added:**

- the **psalter in course**, sung through in order from day to day rather than by the old weekly distribution: monthly at Feuchtwangen 1563 and in the Mecklenburg convents 1572;
- the **Bible in course** (*lectio continua*): Old Testament at Matins, New Testament at Vespers, or the reverse, read through "twice or more in a year" (Pomerania 1535), "in one or two years" (Ansbach 1533), or "the Old Testament once and the New Testament three times a year" (Mecklenburg 1572);
- a **German lesson** after the Latin one, or a German chapter with Veit Dietrich's **summaries** (Naumburg, Saxony 1580, Keppel 1570);
- **German hymns** and the German Litany, especially in the convents and village offices;
- in the evangelical towns, a **sermon** or **catechism** joined to Vespers.

### 10.7.2 Bible lessons in place of homilies

**Pfalz-Neuburg 1543** gives the clearest rule for the Matins lessons. Where nine lessons are kept, three come from the historical books, three from the prophets, and the last three from the Epistles and the Gospel. Each day continues where the last left off.
**Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 77–78):

> doch mit der maß, das man zur metten nicht homilias lese, sonder lectiones aus der biblia. Die mögen in den stiften und clöstern, da man teglich metten singt, also geordnet werden, das, wann man novem lectiones helt, drei aus den historischen büchern der bibel als Mose, Josua, Judicum, Ruth, Samuel, der Könige und Chronica, […] darnach drei aus den propheten und der letsten dreier die ersten zwo aus den episteln, die dritte und letsten aber aus dem evangelio gelesen werden. […] und sollen also aufeinander gehn, daß, wo man heut aufhöret, da sol man morgen wider anheben und also die heiligen schrift ordenlich nacheinander lesen, alweg ein zimlich lange lection, wie bis anher der brauch gewest ist.

yet with this measure, that at Matins no homilies be read, but lessons out of the Bible. These may be so ordered in the chapters and convents where Matins is sung daily, that when nine lessons are kept, three be read from the historical books of the Bible, as Moses, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel, the Kings and Chronicles, […] thereafter three from the prophets, and of the last three, the first two from the Epistles, but the third and last from the Gospel. […] And they shall so follow upon one another, that where one leaveth off today, there one shall begin again tomorrow, and so read the holy Scripture orderly one after another, always a fairly long lesson, as hath been the custom hitherto.

The chapters of Prime, Terce, Sext, None and Compline are likewise to be read in course from the Bible, "so that where one leaveth off at Prime, there one shall begin again at Terce" (Sehling 13, p. 78).

#### 10.7.3 A complete morning office: Braunschweig, 1528

**The school Matins.** Bugenhagen's Braunschweig order describes the boys' daily morning office in full. Two boys intone an antiphon and a Matins psalm, and the choirs sing it with one or two more and an octonary of Psalm 119, which is the psalm of the old little hours. Three boys read the Latin lesson in the Matins tone, and a fourth reads it in German. Then follow the *Benedictus* and the closing prayers (Sehling 6/1, pp. 400–401). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 401):

> Balde darup schal de cantor alleyne singen dat erste halve versch vamme Benedictus nach deme tono der antiphen, de he gedenket, nach deme Benedictus to singen. Dat Benedictus schal geendet werden na gewänheit up beiden chören. Na der antiphen late me de kyndere up de kne vallen unde segge: Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison; Pater noster. De predicante spreke: Et ne nos. Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam. Responsio: Et salutare tuum da nobis. Dominus vobiscum. Oremus cum collecta. Rursum: Dominus vobiscum. Darup singen twe kyndere Benedicamus. Dit alle, weme id gewanen wert, wert kume eyne halve stunde waren.

Straightway thereupon shall the cantor alone sing the first half verse of the *Benedictus*, in the tone of the antiphon which he thinketh to sing after the *Benedictus*. The *Benedictus* shall be finished, as is customary, in both choirs. After the antiphon let the children fall on their knees, and say: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison; Pater noster*. The preacher shall say: *Et ne nos*. *Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam*. Response: *Et salutare tuum da nobis*. *Dominus vobiscum*. *Oremus*, with the collect. Again: *Dominus vobiscum*. Thereupon two children sing the *Benedicamus*. All this, when one is used to it, will scarcely last half an hour.

**The evening office.** The evening office is built the same way. It has the Vesper psalms, four Old Testament lessons, a ferial hymn ("the precious *hymni feriales*, every day one, or at times other fine hymns of Ambrose, Prudentius etc."), and the *Magnificat*. On feast eves and feasts the *Nunc dimittis* is added after the *Benedicamus*, "read slowly … without tone", followed by the Compline hymn *Jesu redemptor saeculi* (Sehling 6/1, p. 401). Matins, Lauds, the little hours, Vespers and Compline are all present in miniature, folded into two half-hour services.

#### 10.7.4 Sunday Vespers in a Lutheran town, 1581

By the later century the town Vespers was a preaching service built on the old frame. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1150):

> Deß Sontags sol man umb ein uhr zur vesper leuten, und sol der schulmeister mit den knaben in den chor gehen und drey psalm Davids mit einer antiphen singen. Darauf sol ein knabe eine lateinische lection aus dem neuen testament und folgends ein ander knabe deudsch darauf lesen. Darnach sol der organist den hymnum schlagen. Nach dem hymno singet man einen deudschen psalm. Darauf folget die predigt. Nach der predigt singet man abermal einen deudschen psalm, darauf das Magnificat. Nach dem Magnificat die collect und das Benedicamus.

On Sunday one shall ring to Vespers at one o'clock, and the schoolmaster shall go with the boys into the choir and sing three psalms of David with an antiphon. Thereupon shall a boy read a Latin lesson out of the New Testament, and next another boy [read] it in German. Thereafter the organist shall play the hymn. After the hymn a German psalm is sung. Thereupon followeth the sermon. After the sermon a German psalm is sung again, thereupon the *Magnificat*. After the *Magnificat* the collect and the *Benedicamus*.

#### 10.7.5 The *preces*, the suffrages and the Litany

**What the old office had.** Three kinds of intercession closed the medieval hours. The *preces* were a chain of Kyrie, Our Father, Creed and versicles said kneeling on ferias, chiefly at Lauds, Prime, Vespers and Compline. The editor of the Ansbach order glosses them as "intercessions (as in the Litany), inserted in a set, changing manner into the several orders of prayer" (Sehling 11, p. 313, n. 10). The *suffragia* were commemorations with antiphon, versicle and collect, chiefly of the saints, added after the collect of the day. The **Litany** of the Saints belonged to Rogation and to particular days. The orders treat the three differently: the full *preces* were cut, a short form was kept, the saints' suffrages were dropped, and the Litany came in, in Luther's corrected Latin and his German, as the new common intercession.

**The full preces cut.** Wittenberg's castle church dropped them in 1525. **Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525** (Sehling 1, p. 699):

> Ad primam vero legatur collecta vulgaris, preces (quas vocant) ubique omnino omittantur.

But at Prime let the common collect be read; the *preces* (as they call them) shall be wholly left out everywhere.

The Ansbach chapters were told the same in 1533, and in the same breath given the Litany and two suffrages. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 313–314):

> Die preces sollen sie alle tag underlassen. […] Uns sehe auch fur gut an, das sie am wenigstens ain mal in der wochen als am freitag die letanei hielten, dieweil sant Paulus vermanet, man soll fur alle stend bitten, 1.Tim.2, [1f.], damit das gemain gebet auch in der kirchen plib. Alle suffragia de sanctis sollen sie underlassen; dann sie stellen das vertrauen in die hailigen wider das erst gebot Gottes. Allein mogen sie an den werktagen suffragia pro pace und pro peccatis halten.

The *preces* they shall leave off every day. […] It seemeth good to us also that at the least once in the week, as on Friday, they hold the Litany, since Saint Paul exhorteth that one should pray for all estates, 1 Timothy 2, that the common prayer may abide in the church also. All suffrages *de sanctis* they shall leave off, for they set trust in the saints, against the first commandment of God. Only on the working days they may hold the suffrages *pro pace* and *pro peccatis*.

**The short preces kept.** What survived in the Bugenhagen orders was the core of the old ferial *preces*, said kneeling after the gospel canticle: *Kyrie*, Our Father, *Et ne nos*, the versicle *Ostende nobis*, *Dominus vobiscum*, the collect and *Benedicamus*. Braunschweig 1528 is quoted above (§10.7.3). The same chain stands in Wittenberg 1525 after the *Magnificat* (Sehling 1, p. 698), Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, p. 523), Lübeck 1531 (Sehling 5, p. 348), the Pomeranian *Pia ordinatio* of 1535 after the *Benedictus* (Sehling 4, p. 349), Goslar 1534 (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 263–264), Frankenberg 1542 (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 277), Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 142), Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543 (Sehling 6/1, p. 50) and Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 849). In the parish orders the children kneel and a preacher or one of the boys says the versicle.

**A full German preces: the Mecklenburg convents.** The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 kept a complete set of *preces* in German after the *Benedictus* every day: Kyrie, Creed, Our Father, and a chain of versicles for mercy, the magistrates, the clergy, the people and peace, ending in three collects. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, pp. 258–259):

> Hierauf folgen diese gebete durch das ganze jahr: Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison. oder Herre erbarme dich, Christe erbarme dich, Herre erbarme dich. Darnach spricht die jungfrau, so das gebet angefangen, mit lauter stimme die bekäntniss des christlichen glaubens: Ich glaube in gott vater etc. und das Vater unser etc. Der chor antwortet: Sondern erlöse uns von dem bösen. Die jungfrau: Herr erzeige uns deine gnad Der chor: Und beweise uns deine hülfe. Die jungfrau: Herr hilf unser obrigkeit Der chor: Und höre uns, wen wir dich anrufen. Die jungfrau : Deine priester wollest mit gerechtigkeit kleiden Der chor: Und deine heiligen sollen frölig sein. Die jungfrau: Hilf deinem volke, herr Jesu Christ, Der chor: Und segne, was dein erbtheil ist. Die jungfrau: Verleihe uns frieden gnediglich, Herr gott zu unsern zeiten. Der chor: Den es ist kein ander nicht, Der für uns könnte streiten, Den du, unser gott, alleine. Die jungfrau: Schaff in uns gott ein rein herze. Der chor: Und nim deinen heiligen geist nicht von uns. Die jungfrau : Der herr sei mit euch Der chor: Und mit deinem geist. Lasset uns beten: Hierauf folgen täglich drei collecten: Die erste von der zeit, Die andere vom frieden. […] Die dritte für gottes wort und erhaltung in wahren glauben.

Hereupon follow these prayers through the whole year: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison*; or, Lord, have mercy; Christ, have mercy; Lord, have mercy. Thereafter the virgin who began the prayer saith with a loud voice the confession of the Christian faith, I believe in God the Father etc., and the Our Father etc. The choir answereth: But deliver us from evil. The virgin: Lord, show us thy grace. The choir: And show us thy help. The virgin: Lord, help our magistrates. The choir: And hear us when we call upon thee. The virgin: Thy priests wilt thou clothe with righteousness. The choir: And thy saints shall be joyful. The virgin: Help thy

people, Lord Jesus Christ. The choir: And bless that which is thine inheritance. The virgin: Grant us peace graciously, Lord God, in our days. The choir: For there is none other that could fight for us, but thou, our God, alone. The virgin: Create in us, God, a clean heart. The choir: And take not thy Holy Spirit from us. The virgin: The Lord be with you. The choir: And with thy spirit. Let us pray. Hereupon follow daily three collects: the first of the season, the other for peace, [...] the third for God's word and preservation in the true faith.

The versicles are the old *preces* of Lauds and Vespers in German: *Ostende nobis*, *Domine salvum fac regem*, *Sacerdotes tui induantur iustitia*, *Salvum fac populum tuum*, *Da pacem* and *Cor mundum*, with Luther's "Verleih uns Frieden" in place of *Fiat pax*. At Vespers the same order sets the Kyrie, Creed, Ten Commandments and Our Father before "*Ostende nobis domine misericordiam tuam* [...] *Domine salvum fac regem* [...] together with the other suffrages, in German (or in Latin, if the virgins understand it), as they are set down above at Matins" (Sehling 5, p. 259).

**The saints' suffrages dropped.** The Saxon visitors of 1529 close Vespers "with the customary versicles and collects, the suffrages of the saints excepted". **Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 527):

> darnach aber das magnificat mit den gewonlichen versikeln und collecten, suffragia sanctorum ausgenomen, und durch die kirchen etwan geistlich lied gesungen werden.

but thereafter the *Magnificat* with the customary versicles and collects, the *suffragia sanctorum* excepted, and some spiritual song be sung by the church.

The same clause stands in the visitation orders for Eilenburg (Sehling 1, p. 560) and Niemegk (Sehling 1, p. 616). Coburg 1545 ends Vespers with the collect of the season and *Benedicamus*, "so that all suffrages be left out" (Sehling 1, p. 543). Bonnus's order for the Osnabrück chapters (1543) puts the "*Suffragia et invocationes sanctorum*" with vigils and prayers for the dead among things "contrary to the word of God" (Sehling 7/1, p. 229).

**Suffrages that stayed.** Only intercessions for the living stayed. Ansbach kept *pro pace* and *pro peccatis* (above). The Transylvanian Saxons kept three suffrages, for the king, for the remission of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects, after the Creed in the service that replaced the Mass when no one communed (Sehling 24, p. 223; Chapter 13, §13.22.1).

The suffrage for peace survived most widely as the *Da pacem* in Latin and German, with a collect *pro pace*, after the *Magnificat* (Dresden, Kreuzkirche 1574, Sehling 1, p. 555; Pomerania 1542, Sehling 4, p. 354).

**The Litany at Vespers.** The Litany most often took the place of the *Magnificat* or followed it, and the Saturday and feast-eve Vespers were its usual hour. Bugenhagen's Pomeranian order has the boys read Luther's Latin Litany after the Saturday Vespers lessons, but not on the eve of a feast. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 340):

> Balde up de lectiones schölen dree eder veere iungen, wo de scholmeisters will, de latinische letanie lesen ut dem sankbökeken doctoris Martini Luther. Unde dat chor schal stedes entwerden, wo im sankbökeken vorvatet is, dar up lest de predicant eine collect, pro ecclesia, unde na dem amen singe man benedicamus. Overst tor vesper, went idt des anderen dages sunderlick fest is, so schal me na den lectionibus nicht de letanie lesen, sundern dat magnificat latinisch singen mit einer antiphen

Straightway after the lessons shall three or four boys, as the schoolmasters will, read the Latin Litany out of Doctor Martin Luther's little song-book; and the choir shall always answer, as is set down in the song-book; thereupon the preacher readeth a collect *pro ecclesia*, and after the Amen let *Benedicamus* be sung. But at Vespers, when the next day is a special feast, one shall not read the Litany after the lessons, but sing the *Magnificat* in Latin with an antiphon.

Once a week the boys sang the German Litany with the people before the sermon instead of the office (Sehling 4, p. 342). The Pomeranian order of 1542 allows the Latin Litany in place of the *Magnificat* "when one keepeth plainly *dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent, and otherwise when one will", followed by the collect *pro ecclesia* and *Da pacem* (Sehling 4, p. 354). The *Agenda* of 1569 makes it monthly. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

> Alle maente schal men in der vesper am viravende singen, ein mal loco magnificat, dat düdische magnificat, mit siner antiphen, Christum unsen heiland etc., unde ein mal de latinische letanie, loco magnificat. Dar na lest de prester eine collecte düdisch edder latinisch, unde beslüt dat chor mit dem benedicamus, unde singet dar up, da pacem domine, flexis genibus, latinisch edder düdisch.

Every month one shall sing at Vespers on the eve [of the holy day], once *loco Magnificat*, the German *Magnificat* with its antiphon, "Christum unsern Heiland" etc., and once the Latin Litany *loco Magnificat*. Thereafter the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir closeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem, Domine*, on bended knees, in Latin or German.

Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel puts the Latin Litany after the hymn at the Vespers of holy eves, sung by two or three children, and leaves the German Litany for the weekday sermon. **Brunswick- Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 51):

> Na dem hymno scholen twe edder dre kindere balde de latinische litania singen. Darna eine collecten und Benedicamus. Overst de düdesche litania mach men in der weken einmal na der predike laten singen, dat de ganze kercke antwerde, wenn de parhere wil.

After the hymn shall two or three children straightway sing the Latin Litany; thereafter a collect and *Benedicamus*. But the German Litany one may let be sung once in the week after the sermon, that the whole church answer, if the parson will.

The Sunday and feast-day Vespers are to be held "without the litany" (Sehling 6/1, p. 53), and Hildesheim 1544 copies the rule (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 850–851). Other places:

- **Wittenberg 1533**: the Latin Litany in the choir after the sermon at Saturday Vespers, closed with a Latin versicle, collect and *Benedicamus* (Sehling 1, pp. 703, 705);
- **Bremen 1534**: the German Litany after the *Magnificat* at the daily evening office of the schools (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 458);
- **Osnabrück 1543**: the German or Latin Litany at times "in the morning, also at Vespers, for all needs of body and soul that lie upon us" (Sehling 7/1, p. 256);
- **Thorn 1575**: on Fridays, in place of Vespers, on alternate weeks a figured Passion, or a figured piece followed by the Latin Litany with a collect (Sehling 4, p. 239).

**The Litany at the morning office.** The Litany was also joined to the morning office:

- **Hamburg 1556**: after the *Benedictus* "at times the *Quicunque vult*, at times the Litany in Latin or German *cum oratione*" (Sehling 5, p. 553);
- **Danzig 1557**: on Friday the weekday Matins "with the litanies to be sung besides" (Sehling 4, p. 181);
- **Remse 1533** (with the Altenburg convent): the nuns hold the German Litany "every week on Wednesday and Friday after the *Benedictus*, before the collect" (Sehling 1, p. 652).

The Brandenburg convents sang it after Prime. **Crevese, *Visitations-Rezess* for the Benedictine convent, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 203):

> Doch schollen die junkfrowen alle sondage, mondage, middewoke und fridage die litanei, wo in drudde deil der ordnung to finden mit aller andacht des morgens na der prime singen und alle dartho kommen.

Yet the virgins shall every Sunday, Monday, Wednesday and Friday sing the Litany, as it is to be found in the third part of the order, with all devotion in the morning after Prime, and all shall come thereto.

The visitors repeated the rule, for Monday, Wednesday and Friday, at Spandau in 1541 (Sehling 3, p. 305) and in the Salzwedel convent in 1579 (Sehling 3, p. 272).

**The Litany in place of the *preces* and the *Salve*.** At the Altenburg chapter in 1533 the canons were to hold "for the *preces* the pure new Litany" (§10.4.2). At Heilbronn in 1532 the evening *Salve* became "a blessing for sleep": the schoolmaster and his boys sing "a German song of praise, as the Litany, or *Mitten wir im Leben sind*, or *Da pacem Domine*", with a collect (Sehling 17/1, p. 302).

**What was not found.** No order keeps the Litany of the Saints with its invocations in any office, and no order uses *suffragia* in the liturgy for anything but the saints' commemorations or the three intercessions for peace, sins and the ruler. The Mass and the weekday prayer services, where the Litany was most at home, are treated in Chapter 13, §13.22.

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## 10.8 Latin, German, or both

### 10.8.1 Latin: chapters, schools, and the towns

**Latin for the learned.** The full cursus in the chapters stayed Latin (§10.4.2):

- **Brandenburg 1540** "in Latin … according to each bishopric's Breviary";
- **Goslar 1534**, where Widensee "holds fast to the use of the Latin language" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 199);
- **Naumburg cathedral**, with a German lesson added;
- the canons' orders of **Bugenhagen** and **Bonnus**.

**The schools.** The school offices were Latin by design. Luther wanted "to keep and exercise the youth in the Latin tongue in the Bible" (§10.3.3). Wittenberg 1533 forbids German singing by the boys except when the people sing with them. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 703):

> Der schulmeister soll mit den kindern nicht stets einerlei singen, sondern mancherlei antiphon, responsoria, hymnos und andere gesenge, so rein aus der heiligen schrift genomen sein. […] Distincte und verstendig soll man psalmen und lectiones lesen und nicht ungeschickt singen. Deutsch sollen die schüler nicht singen, on allein, wenn das volk mitsinget.

The schoolmaster shall not always sing one thing with the children, but divers antiphons, responsories, hymns and other chants that are taken purely out of holy Scripture. […] Distinctly and with understanding shall the psalms and lessons be read, and not sung unskilfully. In German the scholars shall not sing, save only when the people sing with them.

**Understanding the Latin.** Where Latin stayed, the orders tried to make it understood:

- **Braunschweig 1528**: "better diligence shall be applied, that the children learn to understand the Latin which they sing and read" (Sehling 6/1, p. 400).
- **Lohr 1588**: the Latin Vesper psalms "shall be explained in the school as far as needful, so far as it is possible to grasp them" (Sehling 11, p. 699).

### 10.8.2 German: convents and villages

**German psalmody in the convents.** Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 wants the women of the convents to psalm in German, on the old tones. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 78):

> Und dieweil die ganz biblia diser zeit fleißig verteutscht, zuvor aber der psalter dermaßen an tag gebracht, das er im teutschen liechter ist dann in andern sprachen, so sollen die frauen in den klöstern lernen teutsch psallirn in gewonlichem ton, wie sie lateinisch pflegen, und ire lectiones, capitula und collecten teutsch lesen, damit sie dester mer gebessert und zu reichlicher erkantnus Gottis worts mögen kommen.

And since the whole Bible hath at this time been diligently put into German, and the psalter above all hath been so brought to light that it is clearer in German than in other tongues, the women in the convents shall learn to psalm in German in the customary tone, as they are wont [to do] in Latin, and read their lessons, chapters and collects in German, that they may be the more edified and come to a richer knowledge of God's word.

**German instead of the hours.** Other convent orders replace the Latin hours with a German office of psalms, a chapter and a canticle. **Kloster Remse, *Ein kurze christliche ordnung in das junkfrau closter*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 652):

> so sollen sie hinfur an stat der metten, prim, terz, sext, non, lesen drei deutsche psalmen, ein capitel aus den evangelisten an Sant Mathes anzufahen, das benedictus und ein reine collecten von der zeit; fur die vesper desgleichen auch drei psalm, ein capitel aus Sant Pauls episteln, der zum Romern anzufahen, das magnificat und ein collecten alles deutsch.

they shall henceforth, in place of Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext [and] None, read three German psalms, a chapter out of the evangelists beginning at St Matthew, the *Benedictus* and a pure collect of the season; for Vespers likewise also three psalms, a chapter out of St Paul's epistles, beginning at that to the Romans, the *Magnificat* and a collect, all in German.

**The seven hours in German.** The Nassau-Dillenburg order for the convent of **Keppel (1570)** keeps all seven hours, Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline, but in German. It gives the reason that the old Church divided its spiritual exercises into set times "in remembrance of the bitter passion and death of our Lord Jesus Christ". **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 133):

> wöllenn wir, das dieselbige auch noch also gehalltenn werden, doch inn teutscher, verstendiger sprache, ihnen selbst unnd andern zur besserung und erbawung. Unnd sollenn derohalbenn alle closterjungfrawen deß morgens zur mettenzeit, darnach zur prim, tertz, sext unnd non, gegen abendt aber zur vesperzeit unnd complet, mit zucht unnd andacht miteinander inn den chor gehenn unnd inn gemein zu allenn zeiten erstlich die antiphon: Kom, heyliger geist, mit einem deutschenn verß unnd collect de spiritu sancto singenn.

we will that the same be still so kept, yet in the German understandable tongue, to their own and others' amendment and edification. And therefore all the convent virgins shall in the morning at the time of Matins, thereafter at Prime, Terce, Sext and None, but toward evening at the time of Vespers and Compline, go together into the choir with discipline and devotion, and at all times first sing together the antiphon "Komm, Heiliger Geist", with a German verse and the collect of the Holy Ghost.

The Matins that follows has a German *Venite*, three psalms in course "with a short summary before or after each", a German hymn "in place of the antiphon", an Old Testament lesson with Veit Dietrich's summary, and so on. On feasts the psalms and lessons are those "noted in their Breviary" (Sehling 10, pp. 133–134). Sehling's introduction notes an earlier Nassau order of 1558 that "prescribed the keeping of the seven hours in the German language" (Sehling 10, p. 31).

**The Mecklenburg convents, 1572.** The Mecklenburg convents read the whole psalter monthly and the Bible yearly, "in understandable German mother tongue" (Sehling 5, p. 257). Their daily office is led by the domina and the nuns in weekly turn. It opens with the German versicle "Herr thue meine lippen uf" and its *Gloria Patri* (Sehling 5, p. 257).

**Villages.** In the villages the office was German: "all shall be sung in German in the villages" (Lippe 1571, §10.6.4).

#### 10.8.3 Both

**Mixed Latin and German.** Many orders mix the two languages within the same office.

- **The lessons.** Bugenhagen and his followers have the lesson read in Latin and then in German (Braunschweig 1528, Prussia 1568, Hoya 1581). Luther's *Deutsche Messe* had already done so (§10.3.3).
- **The parishes in Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543.** At Vespers "a whole German chapter out of the New Testament [is to be read] instead of the Latin, and concluded with a German collect". The same applies "in all the other hours that are sung in the parish churches", that "the lessons and chapters together with the collects be kept in the German tongue for the people's sake" (Sehling 13, p. 78).
- **The Lüneburg convents, 1574.** The convents mix Latin and German psalms in each hour. **Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke Wilhelm the Younger, 1574** (Sehling 6/1, p. 620):

> so sollen in der metten nicht mehr dan drei lateinische und ein teutscher psalmen und zwo lectiones, dero eine soll ein halb oder dritte teil von einem capittel im neuen testament teutsch sein, und die collect und was sonst mehr gewonlich und christlich ist, darbei zu singen, gesungen und gelesen werden. Wan aber sonst festtage sein, sollen sie vier lateinische und zwen teutsche psalmen und drey lectiones […] singen und lesen.

there shall be sung and read at Matins no more than three Latin and one German psalm, and two lessons, whereof one shall be a half or a third part of a chapter of the New Testament in German, and the collect and whatever else is customary and Christian to sing therewith. But when there are feast days, they shall sing and read four Latin and two German psalms and three lessons […].

Prime and Terce have "a Latin and a German psalm and a collect". Sext and None have "two Latin and one German psalm and a collect". At Compline the hymn "Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht" is sung "in German" (Sehling 6/1, p. 621). Matins is moved from midnight to four or five in the morning, "since the choir virgins grow daily older and more infirm" (Sehling 6/1, p. 620).

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## 10.9 The music

#### 10.9.1 The old chant kept

**"Out of the former choir books."** The chapters kept their medieval chant books. Brandenburg 1540 orders the office sung "according to each bishopric's Breviary, out of the former choir books" (§10.4.2). Verden cathedral in 1606 still sings Vespers "as

the old order bringeth with it" (Sehling 7/1, p. 153). The convents kept their Breviaries, corrected (Spandau 1541; Lüneburg 1555, §10.4.4). The Keppel order of 1570 refers its nuns to "their Breviary" for the feasts.

**The old tones.** The orders also keep the old reciting tones:

- **Pfalz-Neuburg 1543**: even when the nuns psalm in German, they are to do it "in the customary tone, as they are wont in Latin" (§10.8.2).
- **Bugenhagen**: the lessons are sung "with such a tone as one is wont to read lessons at Matins", with the cadence of the old prophecy tone, "*sol sol sol la sol fa fa*" (Sehling 6/1, p. 400; Sehling 4, p. 349).
- **Wittenberg 1533**: the boys end each lesson "as one was wont to read or sing the prophecies, *sol sol mi fa sol sol*" (Sehling 1, p. 703; see Chapter 4, §4.5.1).
- **Prussia 1568**: the Latin lesson is read "*in usitato tono*", the German one "without tone" (§10.6.1).

### 10.9.2 The new chant books: Spangenberg and Lossius

**The Lutheran antiphoners.** From the 1540s the old office chant reached Lutheran schools and churches in two printed Lutheran collections:

- Johann Spangenberg's *Cantiones ecclesiasticae latinae … Kirchengesenge Deudsch* (Magdeburg 1545);
- Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia, hoc est, cantica sacra veteris ecclesiae selecta* (Nürnberg 1553, with a preface by Melanchthon; second edition Wittenberg 1561).

Both preserved the medieval antiphons, responsories, hymns and psalm tones, purged of what was *de sanctis*. Several orders require them by name. **Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

> Es wird für gut angesehen und notig eracht, das man in allen kirchen halten sol Lucae Lossii psalmodia und sol sich das chor darnach richten.

It is deemed good and held necessary that Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia* be kept in all churches, and that the choir order itself thereafter.

**Oldenburg 1573** wants "a right, pure cantional" in every church and school: "that of the old Master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German hymnbook of Dr Martin Luther". The organist alternates with the choir in the responsory, hymn and *Magnificat*. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1085):

> Wo orgeln sind, sol nach den psalmen der organist ein moteten spielen, darauf die lectio gelesen wird, nach welcher der organist das responsorium oder hymnum sol anfahen fortzuschlahen, wie sich denn alwegen dergegen der schulmeister und organist miteinander vergleichen sollen, und alsdenn in dem Magnificat ein vers umb den andern schlagen und singen. Zu der behülf ist vonnöten, das in allen kirchen und schulen ein rechtes, reines cantional stetigs zur hand sey, als nemlich des alten herrn Johan. Spangebergii oder Lucae Lossii sampt dem deudschen gesangbuch D. Martini Lutheri.

Where there are organs, the organist shall play a motet after the psalms, whereupon the lesson is read; after which the organist shall begin to play the responsory or hymn, as the schoolmaster and organist shall always agree with one another thereon; and then in the *Magnificat* play and sing one verse after the other. To this end it is needful that in all churches and schools a right, pure cantional be always at hand, namely that of the old Master Johann Spangenberg or of Lucas Lossius, together with the German hymnbook of Dr Martin Luther.

**Lohr, 1588.** First Vespers of Sundays and feasts are sung in Latin, "according to the order of Lossius's *Psalmodia*, as they are noted for every occasion". **Rieneck, *Vesperordnung zu Lohr*, 1588** (Sehling 11, p. 699):

> (damit die jugent im psalliren und choralgesang, wie in allen kirchen gebreuchlich, geüebet werde) mit lateinischen psalmen, responsoriis, hymnis, Magnificat, collectis, versiculis, Benedicamus und anderm nach ordnung der psalmodiae L. Lossii, wie dieselben nach erheischung jederzeit notiert und bisher in brauch und uebung gewesen, gesungen und gehalten werden

(that the youth be exercised in psalmody and plainchant, as is customary in all churches) [it shall] be sung and kept with Latin psalms, responsories, hymns, *Magnificat*, collects, versicles, *Benedicamus* and the rest, according to the order of L. Lossius's *Psalmodia*, as the same are noted for every occasion and have hitherto been in use and practice

Other orders cite Lossius too:

- **Hof 1592** cites antiphons "in Lossius's *Psalmodia*" and "in the great thin antiphoner" (Sehling 11, p. 422).
- **Lüneburg 1575** refers to "Lossius's book" for the festal Compline (Sehling 6/1, p. 658).
- **Buxtehude 1565** takes its noted pieces from Lossius's second edition (Sehling 7/1, p. 67, introduction).

#### 10.9.3 German psalm tones

**Keppel, 1570.** The German office at Keppel is sung from the printed German psalm-books with their notes. The preacher is to teach the nuns the melodies. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 133):

> Es sollenn auch die zwen chore einen verß umb den andern singen unnd die tonos verendern, wie dan dieselbige inn [...] den teutschen psalmen buchern, so zu Leypzig außgangen, mit iren noten unnd melodien beschrieben seindt, hierinnen soll sie der prediger underweisen, das sie die melodien und noten konnen lernen.

The two choirs also shall sing one verse after the other, and change the tones, as the same are written down with their notes and melodies in [...] the German psalm-books that have come out at Leipzig; herein shall the preacher instruct them, that they may learn the melodies and notes.

Sehling's editor identifies the book as probably Luther's hymnbook printed by Valentin Babst at Leipzig in 1545 (Sehling 10, p. 133, n. 13). Here the old psalm tones carry the German psalter.

**German canticles.** Luther's own German versions of the office canticles came into use beside the Latin:

- the German *Te Deum* ("Herr Gott, dich loben wir"), sung at Wittenberg 1533 in alternation between the choir and the people (Sehling 1, p. 705);
- the German *Magnificat*, sung at Hof 1592 "in the sixth tone" (below).

#### 10.9.4 Figural music and the organ

**Polyphony at the office.**

- **Wittenberg 1533**: "when the cantors sing *in figurativis*" at Vespers, they sing everything with the *Magnificat* before the sermon, and on Sundays "after the *Benedicamus* let the boys sing the *Nunc dimittis in figurativis* or in counterpoint" (Sehling 1, pp. 703, 705).
- **Württemberg cloister schools, 1582 edition**: the singing is to be "directed to counterpoint, whereby it is so much the lovelier and more understandable" (Sehling 16, p. 366, apparatus).
- **Hof 1592**: Vespers may be sung *figuraliter*. Its Saturday Vespers has the German *Magnificat* in the sixth tone, with boys and girls in alternation and the organ between. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 429):

> Magnificat germanicum sexti toni per binos choros distinctis scholasticis canitur, videlicet unus versus a pueris, alter a puellis, praemissa semper melodia ab organicine et tertio quoque versu omisso. Si organorum usus non adhibetur, a dictis choris integrum Magnificat completur. [...] Si figuraliter vespertinus actus peragitur, I. psalmus, II. antiphonon, III. responsorium, IIII. unus atque alter versus ex hymno, V. muteta ante concionem, VI. Magnificat certi toni cantore regente canitur.

The German *Magnificat* of the sixth tone is sung by two choirs, the scholars being divided, namely one verse by the boys, the other by the girls, the melody being always first played by the organist, and every third verse being omitted. If the organ is not used, the whole *Magnificat* is completed by the said choirs. [...] If the Vesper service is performed figurally, [then] I. the psalm, II. the antiphon, III. the responsory, IIII. one or another verse of the hymn, V. a motet before the sermon, [and] VI. the *Magnificat* in a set tone are sung under the direction of the cantor.

Hof's order notes that the plainchant pieces are written out for every Sunday and feast so that they can be used "when, perhaps because of public mourning, the songs of figural music have no place" (Sehling 11, p. 450).

**The organ.** The organ alternated with the choir in the office, as in the Mass:

- **Prussia 1568**: the organist "playeth one verse after the other" in the *Magnificat*, and a piece after the *Nunc dimittis* (Sehling 4, p. 75).
- **Pomerania 1569**: "where there are organs, the organist shall be at the organ after the psalmody, and play to the responsory, hymn and *Magnificat*" (Sehling 4, p. 435).
- **Oldenburg 1573** (above) and **Hoya 1581**: the organist "plays the hymn" (§10.7.4).
- **Wittenberg castle, 1525**: the organ only "on Sunday to the *Te Deum laudamus*, and whenever German songs are sung" (Sehling 1, p. 699).

**In sum.** The medieval office chant was neither abandoned nor wholly reset. In the chapters and convents it went on from the old books. In the schools and towns it was purged and reprinted in the Lutheran antiphoners of Spangenberg and Lossius. Beside it stood:

- Luther's German canticles and hymns;
- German psalms sung to the old tones;
- by the later century, polyphony and organ alternation on Sundays and feasts.

The organ in the service as a whole is treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.

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## 10.10 The catechism service

**A new office.** The catechism service (*Katechismus*, *Kinderlehre*, *Kinderpredigt*, *examen catechismi*) had no place in the medieval cursus. The Reformation made it, for the children, the servants and "the simple", and it became the one weekly service besides the Mass and Vespers that nearly every order prescribes. It took three forms:

- **a service of its own**, usually on Sunday at midday or early afternoon, with hymn, prayer, recitation of the text, a short exposition, examination of the young, prayer and blessing (§§10.10.2–10.10.3);
- **a catechism joined to Vespers**, where a boy recited the chief parts, or the catechism was preached in place of the Vespers sermon (§10.10.4);
- **a recitation inside another service**: the text of the catechism read before or after the morning sermon, or at the weekday offices (§10.10.5).

The Reformed orders built a fourth form on the same plan: the catechism divided into Sundays, the youth reciting a fixed portion, and the minister expounding it (§10.10.6). How often the catechism was taught, and what had to be known before first communion, are treated in Chapter 15, §15.11; the catechism sermon as a sermon in Chapter 11, §11.4.3.

### 10.10.1 Origins: Luther and Wittenberg

**A weekday lesson and a Sunday sermon.** Luther's *Deutsche Messe* of 1526 set the catechism on weekday mornings: "on Monday and Tuesday early there is a German lesson on the Ten Commandments, on the Creed and Our Father, on baptism and the sacrament, that these two days may keep up the catechism and strengthen it in its right understanding" (Sehling 1, pp. 13–14). By 1533 the Wittenberg town church gave it the first service of Sunday. "On Sunday early a priest or deacon shall preach out of the catechism, and when the catechism is ended, begin it again"; after the sermon "all the words of the catechism" were to be said to the people, with Christ's command concerning both sacraments. A fourth deacon rode out to the villages after the high Mass on holy days to preach the catechism to the peasants, with a German psalm before and after (Sehling 1, pp. 700–701).

### 10.10.2 When, and how long

**The hour.** Most orders set the catechism at midday or early afternoon on Sunday, after the morning service and dinner:

- at **twelve**, when the clock had struck (Neckarbischofsheim 1560), or at twelve after an hour of psalm-singing from eleven (Rostock, *Conformitas*, c. 1560);
- at **one** (Mecklenburg 1552; Sangerhausen 1555; Lippe 1571; Oldenburg 1573);
- at **one or two**, "as the occasion of the place may suffer" (Pfalz-Veldenz 1574);
- "straight at midday or at Vespers time" in the Württemberg villages (1553).

Some places put it first in the day instead: at Schwäbisch Hall (1543) it was held at six in summer and seven in winter, before the main service, and Pomerania (1569) allowed "early in the morning or at twelve at midday" (Sehling 4, p. 385). Weekday catechisms were set by the convenience of the work: on Tuesday afternoon at two in winter and Thursday at twelve in summer at Brandis (1574, Sehling 1, p. 534); on Monday at two or three for the public examination at Thorn (1575, Sehling 4, pp. 236, 238).

**The length.** The orders that set a length give **half an hour** for the exposition or the examination, and **an hour** at most for the whole:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed): the youth "is questioned and taught in the catechism about half an hour" every Sunday (Sehling 8, p. 252);
- the Palatinate (1601, Reformed): "some questions … expounded for half an hour" (Sehling 14, p. 558);
- Thorn (1575): "half a little hour" of catechism preaching between the hymn and the *Magnificat* at Sunday Vespers (Sehling 4, p. 238);
- Emden (Micron, 1565, Reformed): the children examined "when the minister hath preached half an hour" (Sehling 7/1, p. 606);
- Rostock (c. 1560): the midday sermon on the catechism "shall not last over an hour" (Sehling 5, p. 289);
- Hohenlohe (1596): the whole act, sermon read, examination, summary, hymn, prayer and blessing, "which shall in no wise last over an hour long" (Sehling 15, p. 663).

Veit Dietrich's Nürnberg *Agendbüchlein* (1545) joins a catechism sermon, read from the printed book, to the Litany on the one weekday when the people met, "so that this be ended in about half an hour at the longest, and the people come again to their work" (Sehling 11, p. 504).

**The season.** Nassau-Dillenburg (1575, Philippist) held the Sunday afternoon *Kinderlehre* only "from Whitsun until Michaelmas", with a weekday hour through the whole year in the towns (Sehling 10, p. 148). At Obermaßfeld (Henneberg, 1563) the pastor took the Passion history instead of the catechism in Lent, and gave the children questions on the Passion (Sehling 2, p. 343). Limpurg (1610) let the catechism sermon and the children's recitation fall on Easter, Whitsun and a Christmas falling on Sunday (Sehling 16, p. 616).

### 10.10.3 The order of the Lutheran catechism service

**The common shape.** The Lutheran orders vary in detail but agree on a shape:

1. a bell, often the small bell;
2. a hymn, usually one of Luther's catechism hymns (the Ten Commandments, *Wir glauben*, *Vater unser im Himmelreich*, *Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam*);
3. the Our Father or a prayer for the understanding of the word;
4. the text of the chief parts, said aloud by the pastor or recited by boys;
5. the exposition of one part, taken in course, "and when it is ended, begin again";
6. the examination of the children, by question and answer;
7. a prayer or collect, often a prayer for the children;
8. a hymn and the blessing.

**Mecklenburg, 1552: the North German pattern.** The Mecklenburg order put the children's instruction before the sermon and joined both to Vespers canticles. Its paragraph was copied word for word by Oldenburg (1573), and closely by Lüneburg (1564) and Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1569) (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1095, n. 6). **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 200):

> Nach mittag um eins sollen die schuler anfahen einen psalm oder zween zu singen. Oder singen die zehen gebot, Vater unser im himelreich, Christ, unser herr, zum Jordan kam, und der gleichen. Darnach unterweise der prediger die kinder im catechismo. Also, das er sie nacheinander frage, und lasse im die zehen gebot auswendig sagen, item, die auslegung, welche die kinder von wort zu wort aus dem kleinen catechismo D. Martini Lutheri sollen lernen und uffsagen. Desgleichen neme er ein ander mal ein ander stück des catechismi für sich, bis zu end. Und alsdenn sol man widerum von fornen anfahen. Darnach singe man das magnificat. Darnach gehet der prediger uff die canzel, und spricht aus mit lauter stimme die zehen gebot, das symbolum, das vater unser, die wort von der tauf und die wort des abendmals. Denn nimt er ein stück des catechismi für sich, mit vleis dem volk furzutragen und zu erkleren. Zu end der predigt vermanet er

> das volk zum gebet. Nach der predigt singet man: Herr, nu lest du deinen diener im friede faren, darauf wird eina collect gelesen und mit dem benedicamus domino beschlossen.

In the afternoon at one the scholars shall begin to sing a psalm or two; or they sing the Ten Commandments, *Vater unser im Himmelreich*, *Christ unser Herr zum Jordan kam*, and the like. Thereafter let the preacher instruct the children in the catechism; that is, that he question them one after another, and let them say the Ten Commandments to him by heart, item the exposition, which the children shall learn and say off word for word out of the Small Catechism of Dr Martin Luther. Likewise let him another time take another part of the catechism in hand, unto the end; and then shall one begin again from the front. Thereafter let the *Magnificat* be sung. Thereafter the preacher goeth up into the pulpit and speaketh out with a loud voice the Ten Commandments, the Creed, the Our Father, the words of baptism and the words of the Supper. Then he taketh a part of the catechism in hand, to set it forth to the people with diligence and to explain it. At the end of the sermon he exhorteth the people to prayer. After the sermon is sung *Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace*; thereupon a collect is read, and it is concluded with the *Benedicamus Domino*.

**Neckarbischofsheim, 1560: a full ordo.** A small Kraichgau order sets the midday catechism out step by step. **Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 16, p. 672):

> Uff den Mittage, nach dem essen, pflegt man den Catechismum und Kinderlere zu halten, da man dis singt: Herre gott, dein trew mit gnaden laist, oder sonsten, was darzu dienstlich ist. Es wirt aber die ordnung also gehalten. Erstlich, wan es 12 ur geschlagen, leut man mit dem kleinen glöcklin ein gut, lang zaichen. Nach solchem fahet man an zu singen das vatter unser oder sonsten ein gesang. Wan soliches bei dem End ist, so geht der pfarrherr uf die Cantzel, explicirt den Catechismum, nimet ein hauptstuckh nach dem andern. So ers vollendt, fahet ers widerumb an. Nach solichem, so die predig vollendt, verlist er alle 6 stuckh Christlicher ler uß dem Catechismo Lutheri. So ers zum End bracht, recitiren die Knaben den Catechismum, doch ein stuckh umbs ander, alle Suntag eins. Nachmalen verlist der pfarrherr das folgend hauptstuckh, das nach dem volgt, so die Knaben gerecitirt haben. Darnach so fragt [er] etliche under dem jungen volckhe, nach solchem beschleust ers mit eim gebet, wie im Catechismo Luteri verzaichnet stet. Hierauf, nach dem das gebet uß, sagt der pfarrherr: Lassent uns gott, dem herren, danckhen mit dem lobgesang. Hierauf singt der Schul[meister], oder wer an sein stat da ist, das leste gesetz in dem gesang: Herr, gott, din trew mit gnaden laist. Darnach tritt der pfarrherr für den altar und gibt den segen

At midday, after dinner, the catechism and children's teaching is wont to be held, whereat this is sung: *Herre Gott, dein Treu mit Gnaden leist*, or else what serveth thereto. But the order is held thus. First, when it hath struck twelve, a good long sign is rung with the small bell. After that they begin to sing the Our Father, or else a hymn. When that is at an end, the pastor goeth up into the pulpit and explaineth the catechism, taking one chief part after another; when he hath finished it, he beginneth it again. After this, when the sermon is finished, he readeth all six parts of Christian doctrine out of Luther's catechism. When he hath brought it to the end, the boys recite the catechism, yet one part after another, one every Sunday. Afterwards the pastor readeth the next chief part, that followeth after that which the boys have recited. Thereafter he questioneth some among the young folk; after that he concludeth it with a prayer, as it standeth set down in Luther's catechism. Hereupon, when the prayer is ended, the pastor saith: Let us thank God the Lord with the song of praise. Hereupon the schoolmaster, or whoso is in his stead, singeth the last stanza of the hymn *Herr Gott, dein Treu mit Gnaden leist*. Thereafter the pastor stepeth before the altar and giveth the blessing.

**Hesse, 1566: two kinds of hearer.** The Hessian order (Moderate Reformed) gives the fullest rationale, and divides the exposition between "the children and simple" and those who have grasped the text. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 251–252):

> Wenn nun die gemeine zum catechismo kommen, werden diese ding nacheinander verrichtet: Erstlich wird ein psalm gesungen, demnach volgt der gesang von zehen gebotten, vom glauben, vom gebet des Herrn etc. […] 2. Zum andern: Nach dem gesang steigt der diener des worts uf den predigstul und erzelt nacheinander laut und verstendlich die stück der kinderlehr, wie die in dem catechismo Lutheri zusamengetragen. […] Wenn nun die predig des catechismi vollendet und die, so den catechismum zu hören verordnet, sich gesetzt haben, probirt der lehrer etliche kinder hin und wider mit fragen und antworten, erfordert von einem dieses stück, vom andern ein anders zu erzelen und zu erkleren. Und so er bei den einfeltigen gar umb gefragt, gehet er fortan zu denen, so im catechismo besser underricht, und erfordert von ihnen ein volkömliche auslegung und bericht. Uf diese weise wird allen sontag und auch die andern tage, so darzu bestimpt, in der wochen die jugend etwa ein halb stund gefragt und underricht im catechismo […] 5. Wird nach dem

> examen des catechismi ein psalm gesungen […] Endlich beschleußt diese action der diener des worts mit dem segen Num. 6, wie breuchlich, und leßt die versamlung gehen.

When now the congregation is come to the catechism, these things are done one after another. First a psalm is sung; next followeth the hymn of the Ten Commandments, of the Creed, of the Lord's Prayer, etc. […] Secondly: after the hymn the minister of the word goeth up into the pulpit and rehearseth one after another, aloud and understandably, the parts of the children's doctrine, as they are gathered together in Luther's catechism. […] When now the sermon of the catechism is ended, and those that are appointed to hear the catechism have sat down, the teacher trieth certain children here and there with questions and answers, requiring of one this part, of another another, to rehearse and to explain. And when he hath gone round the simple, he goeth on to those that are better instructed in the catechism, and requireth of them a full exposition and account. In this wise every Sunday, and also on the other days appointed thereto in the week, the youth is questioned and taught in the catechism about half an hour […] Fifthly, after the examination of the catechism a psalm is sung […] Finally the minister of the word concludeth this action with the blessing of Numbers 6, as is customary, and letteth the assembly go.

Between the recitation and the examination came the sermon, divided into two parts: first "with short and understandable words" for the children and simple, then "with proofs of the sayings of holy Scripture" for those who had the text already (Sehling 8, pp. 251–252). Where the people met only once on Sunday afternoon, Hesse (Moderate Reformed) folded the catechism into the afternoon service: psalm, epistle, its exposition, the catechism read, one part expounded, the children questioned, a psalm and the blessing (Sehling 8, p. 253).

**Württemberg, 1553: exposition, hearing, prayer.** The Württemberg order is briefer. It asks each pastor or deacon to set "a special time" on Sunday for the catechism, chiefly for the young. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 243):

> solle der Pfarrer oder sein Diaconus erstlich ein Puncten oder Artickel des volgenden Catechismi nach dem andern kurtzlich und verstentlich expliciern und außlegen, das die jungen nicht allein der wörter gewonen, sonder auch ein gutten, Christlichen verstand derselben überkommen. Hernach soll er etlich der jungen offentlich verhören, das dardurch nicht allein derselben jungen geschicklicheit erfaren werde, sonder auch die andern den Catechismum von inen lernen mögen, Und sollen die kirchendiener mit der jugendt so freundtlich und holdselig handeln, das sie nicht von dem Catechismo abgeschreckt, sonder darzu lustig werden

the pastor or his deacon shall first explain and expound one point or article of the following catechism after another, briefly and understandably, that the young may not only grow used to the words, but also come by a good, Christian understanding of the same. After that he shall hear certain of the young openly, that thereby not only the aptness of the same young ones be learned, but also the others may learn the catechism from them. And the ministers of the church shall deal with the youth so friendly and graciously that they be not frighted away from the catechism, but made glad thereto.

The service closed with a set prayer, "after the explanation or exposition of the catechism and the children have been heard", for the children whom God "hast given to thy church and born again through holy baptism", that he would "strengthen this thy work which thou hast begun in them" (Sehling 16, p. 246).

**The village catechism: Lippe, 1571.** In the villages, where there was no afternoon sermon, the catechism service was the pastor's and the sexton's alone. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 397):

> Weil auff den Dörffern keine Nachmittags Predigt aus vielen ursachen gehalten werden kan, Sollen dennoch die Pfarrherrn neben dem Küster alle einfeltige, unverstendige Bawrsleuthe, die sein Jung oder Alt, Knaben oder Meidlein, ungefehrlich umb Ein uhr durch einen Glockengeleut zusammen fordern und, wenn dieselben versamblet […] sol ein teutscher Psalm aus den Geistlichen Gesengen, darin ein jeder stück des Catechismi kurtz und rundt verfasset ist, genommen und langsam mit den Kindern gesungen werden. Darauff soll der Pastor die Fünff Heubtstücke der Christlichen Religion, so man nennet den Catechismum, mit klaren, verstendtlichen Worten verlesen und darnach gantz kurtz und einfeltig zu jeder zeit ein Stücke durch Frage und Antwort erkleren

Since in the villages no afternoon sermon can be held, for many causes, the pastors shall nevertheless, together with the sexton, call together by a ringing of the bell, about one o'clock, all simple, unlearned country folk, be they young or old, boys or maidens; and when the same are assembled […] a German psalm shall be taken out of the spiritual songs, in which each part of the catechism is briefly and roundly composed, and sung slowly with the children. Thereupon the pastor shall read the five chief parts of the Christian religion, which are called the catechism, with clear, understandable words, and thereafter explain one part at each time, quite briefly and simply, by question and answer.

Oldenburg (1573) took over the Lippe text (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1113), and Pfalz-Veldenz (1574) has the same order: "short hymn and prayer", the examination with the recitation of the parts, a German psalm, then the sermon with "question and answer" and the closing prayer, hymn and blessing (Sehling 18, p. 523).

**Nördlingen, 1544: recitation by two boys.** In the Swabian towns the recitation was given to the schoolboys. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 319):

> Zu mittage, wenn man den catechismum prediget, so D. Martinus für die ainfeltigen geschriben.
>
> 1. Zum ersten singet man der stuck aines des catechismi, davon man prediget, wie sie D. Luther gemacht hat. 2. Darnach recitirn zween knaben auswendig mit heller stim die hauptartikel des catechismi allain nach dem text. Alsdann das stück allain mit der auslegung davon die predig gehet. 3. Darauf singet das volk: Nun bitten wir, zwai gesetz oder alle vier, und volget alsbald die predigt. 4. Nach der predig ain kurzen psalm nach der zeit, wie oben zum hohen ampt. 5. Zuletzt beschleust der diacon ainer mit gewohnlichem versikel und collecten und segen.

At midday, when the catechism is preached which Dr Martin wrote for the simple. 1. First is sung that one of the parts of the catechism whereof the sermon is, as Dr Luther made them. 2. Thereafter two boys recite by heart with clear voice the chief articles of the catechism, after the text only; then that part alone with the exposition, whereof the sermon goeth. 3. Thereupon the people sing *Nun bitten wir*, two stanzas or all four, and the sermon followeth straightway. 4. After the sermon a short psalm according to the season, as above at the high office. 5. Last of all one of the deacons concludeth with the customary versicle and collect and the blessing.

**Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588.** A Wetterau order gives the same shape with the hymn chosen to fit the part: "when one preacheth the Ten Commandments, then sing the Ten Commandments, and so forth". The pastor recited the five chief parts from the pulpit, expounded one, closed the sermon with prayer, "and then hold the examination with the youth", ending with hymn, prayer "for the preservation of God's word" and blessing (Sehling 10, p. 627).

#### 10.10.4 The catechism in Vespers

**The boy's recitation.** In Saxony and Thuringia the catechism was often built into Sunday Vespers. A boy recited the chief parts between the lesson and the hymn before the sermon, and the Vespers sermon itself might be on the catechism. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 72):

> Zur vesper. 1. Erstlich singet man das te deum laudamus deuzsch oder sonst einen hymnum oder psalm nach der zeit. 2. Darnach lesen zweene knaben das capitel aus den episteln Pauli, einer deuzsch der ander lateinisch. 3. Alsdan recitirt ein knab auswendig die fünf heubtstück des catechismi. 4. Darauf singet man Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist, zwei geseze. 5. Darauf volget die predigt, ein jar umbs ander, das eine jar der kleine catechismus Lutheri, das ander die epistolae dominicales. 6. Das magnificat mit seiner antiphon, Christus unser heiland, oder sonst ein kurz gsang nach der zeit [...] 7. Darnach concludirt man mit der collecten und benedicamus.

At Vespers. 1. First is sung the *Te Deum laudamus* in German, or else a hymn or psalm according to the season. 2. Thereafter two boys read the chapter out of the epistles of Paul, one in German, the other in Latin. 3. Then a boy reciteth by heart the five chief parts of the catechism. 4. Thereupon is sung *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist*, two stanzas. 5. Thereupon followeth the sermon: one year about the other, the one year Luther's Small Catechism, the other the Sunday epistles. 6. The *Magnificat* with its antiphon, *Christus unser Heiland*, or else a short hymn according to the season [...] 7. Thereafter it is concluded with the collect and *Benedicamus*.

**Vespers with an examination.** Sangerhausen in 1555 added the examination at the altar, after the sermon. **Sangerhausen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 658):

> Nachmittags zur vesper umb 1 uhr wirt der catechismus geprediget mit gesengen wie folget: Erstlich singet man mit den knaben einen lateinischen psalmum sampt eine antiphona ex evangelio dominicali. 2. Ein lateinisch responsorium oder hymnum, de tempore. 3. Darauf ein deutschen gesang, das das volk helfen kan. 4. Ein deutsche lection aus dem alten oder neuen testament, lieset ein knabe. 5. Darauf singet man mit dem volk ein deutsch lied gemeiniglich von dem stück des catechismi davon man prediget; oder das deutsche magnificat. 6. Folget die predigt des catechismi nach Lutheri ordnung [...] 7. Nach der predigt singet man ein kirchengesang, als erhalt uns herr bei deinem wort, oder gott der vater wohn uns bei. 8. Indes samlet sich das junge volk zum altar und fraget sie der pfarrherr nach der reihe aus dem

> catechismo, die kurze auslegung Lutheri, nimpt jedesmal 2 gebot, und so fort, bis er in hinausbringet. 9. Wird beschlossen mit dem gesang: verlei uns fried gnediglich, sampt der dazu gehörigen collecta.

In the afternoon at Vespers, at one o'clock, the catechism is preached with hymns as followeth. First a Latin psalm is sung with the boys, together with an antiphon out of the Sunday gospel. 2. A Latin responsory or hymn *de tempore*. 3. Thereupon a German hymn, that the people may help. 4. A German lesson out of the Old or New Testament, which a boy readeth. 5. Thereupon a German song is sung with the people, commonly of the part of the catechism whereof the sermon is; or the German *Magnificat*. 6. The sermon of the catechism followeth, after Luther's order [...] 7. After the sermon a church hymn is sung, as *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort*, or *Gott der Vater wohn uns bei*. 8. Meanwhile the young folk gather at the altar, and the pastor questioneth them in turn out of the catechism, Luther's short exposition, taking two commandments each time, and so forth, until he bring it to the end. 9. It is concluded with the hymn *Verleih uns Frieden gnädiglich*, together with the collect belonging thereto.

**Other Vespers forms.**

- **Regensburg 1553**: at Sunday Vespers the hymn was left out "for the sake of the long catechism", and a piece of the Nürnberg catechism was read from the pulpit, the choir closing with a German psalm suited to it (Sehling 13, p. 421).
- **Sulzfeld 1566**: German psalm and hymn; two boys recite a piece of the catechism "with the exposition"; the German *Te Deum*; then the pastor recites "word for word" the chief parts, the morning and evening blessing and the graces, questions the young, and expounds the next part; German *Magnificat*, collect, *Benedicamus* (Sehling 2, p. 353).
- **Gottleuba 1567**: after the lesson "two boys recite a piece of the holy catechism, and always add the questions on the holy sacrament", before the *Magnificat*; on ordinary Sundays the Vespers sermon was on the catechism (Sehling 1, p. 568).
- **Penig 1575**: after the Vespers *Magnificat* the deacon reads the "table of the six chief parts" or some questions, then expounds one part, so that the catechism is finished each year by Advent; after the sermon the school children, boys and girls on alternate Sundays, say a part with Luther's exposition (Sehling 1, p. 634).
- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: "when Vespers is ended, let a piece of the catechism be taken in hand and expounded to the people in the simplest wise" (Sehling 1, p. 369).
- **Solms-Laubach 1603**: at Saturday and feast-eve Vespers "a boy recites a chief part of the catechism", before the *Magnificat* (Sehling 9, p. 357).

**Thorn, 1575: the catechism through the week.** The Prussian city of Thorn put the catechism into every daily office. At German Matins on weekdays "a boy readeth the *capita catechismi* plainly, and straight thereafter one *caput catechismi* with the exposition" (Sehling 4, p. 238), and the same at weekday Vespers (p. 239), so that "the *capita catechismi* with Luther's exposition shall be read through and repeated weekly" (p. 239). On Sunday and Monday the catechism had services of its own. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 238):

> Am sonntage wird in der altstadt zu S. Johann wie auch in der neustädtischen pfarrkirchen lateinische vesper gesungen, zwischen dem hymnus und magnificat ein halb stündlein vom catechismo gepredigt und die vesper mit einer collect beschlossen; am montage wird im kloster die deutsche vesper eingestellt und dagegen das examen des catechismi hora 2 zu S. Johann gehalten

On Sunday in the Old Town at St John's, as also in the New Town parish church, Latin Vespers is sung; between the hymn and the *Magnificat* half a little hour is preached on the catechism, and Vespers concluded with a collect. On Monday the German Vespers in the cloister is left off, and instead the examination of the catechism is held at two o'clock at St John's.

The same order put the Sunday catechism sermon into both German and Polish, "about half a little hour", and the Monday examination at St John's ran through the catechism "in six weeks", one part each Monday, "and begun again" (Sehling 4, p. 236).

### 10.10.5 The catechism in the morning service

**The text before the gospel or after the sermon.** Many orders had the bare text of the catechism said in the morning service, so that the whole congregation heard it every Sunday:

- **Strasbourg 1548** (Moderate Reformed; an agreement of the clergy on the Interim): after the morning sermon, which was not to run "beyond a third of an hour" at the cathedral and half an hour elsewhere, "the recitation of the six *loci* of the catechism ought to follow the exposition of the gospel"; at the cathedral the first three one Sunday, the other three the next (Sehling 20/1, p. 355).

- **Albertine Saxony 1580**: the visitors asked whether the pastor "speak the catechism to the people on Sundays and holy days before the gospel is read" (Sehling 1, p. 393).
- **Pomerania 1569**: in the villages the sexton is to read a piece of the catechism "after the epistle", and the pastor to preach the catechism in the afternoon (Sehling 4, p. 384).
- **Nördlingen 1579**: on Sundays and holy days, after the epistle and its hymn, "a piece of Luther's catechism is read in order, and when it is ended, it shall be begun again", before the German Creed (Sehling 12, p. 375).
- **The Palatinate 1563** (Reformed): the minister read a portion of the catechism before every Sunday and feast-day sermon, "so that it be read through in nine Sundays" (Sehling 14, p. 342).

**An early catechism service: Schwäbisch Hall, 1543.** Brenz's Hall had the catechism as the first service on Sunday, before the main service, on alternate Sundays examined and preached. On the examination Sundays it borrowed the opening of the Mass. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, pp. 162–163):

> Am Sontag umorgens frü, imm Sommer umb sechs ur und imm Winter umb sieben ur, sol der Catechismus […] inn der Pfarkirchen zu Sanct Michel mit nachfolgender Ordnung gehalten werden, nemlich das die Fragstück auff den ein Sontag von den kindern verhöret und auff den andern Sontag ordenlich nacheinander gepredigt und außgelegt sollen werden. Und so die Fragstück von denn kindern verhöret werden, sol man erstlich das Kyrie eleison sampt dem Teutschen Glori sey Gott in der höhe singen, etc. Darauff sol der Catechista nach geschehenem vorgehendem Gebeet den text deß Evangelions, so rauff den selben Sontag gfallen ist, recitirn und daaus ein Locum communem fuor die Jugent leeren. Hernach sollen die kinder ordenlich, ye par und par, auffgestelt, ye eins das ander die Fragstück im […] offentlich zufragen […] Darauff sollen die Zehen Gebot Teutsch oder ein ander geistlich danck- oder lob gsang nach gelegenheit der zeit gesungen und hernach ein Gebeet für die kinder gesprochen werden

On Sunday early in the morning, in summer at six o'clock and in winter at seven o'clock, the catechism […] shall be held in the parish church of St Michael with the following order: namely, that the questions be heard from the children on the one Sunday, and on the other Sunday be preached and expounded in order one after another. And when the questions are heard from the children, the Kyrie eleison shall first be sung, together with the German *Glory be to God on high*, etc. Thereupon the catechist, after the prayer going before, shall recite the text of the gospel that falleth on the same Sunday, and teach out of it a common place for the youth. After that the children shall be set up in order, pair by pair, each to ask the other the questions in the [catechism] openly […] Thereupon shall be sung the Ten Commandments in German, or another spiritual hymn of thanks or praise according to the season, and after that a prayer for the children shall be said.

The prayer for the children recalls the angels set over children and Christ's "Suffer the children to come unto me", and the blessing follows. On the preaching Sundays the schoolboys sang the Latin introit, Kyrie and *Gloria in excelsis*, and the catechist expounded the gospel briefly and then "a question in the catechism, … until he have preached out the whole catechism" (Sehling 17/1, p. 163).

**A printed catechism sermon.** The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 printed a set of *Kinderpredigten* for pastors to read, each beginning with a "common beginning to all sermons", a greeting and the bidding: "to speak and to learn something profitable of the word of God, desire grace and say an Our Father!" (Sehling 11, p. 206). Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* and the Hohenlohe order of 1596 have the catechism sermon "read" from the printed book, not preached (Sehling 11, p. 504; 15, p. 663).

#### 10.10.6 The Reformed catechism service

**Divided by Sundays.** The Reformed Heidelberg Catechism of 1563 was printed in Sunday divisions so that it could be recited and expounded in a year. Its order sets the afternoon service. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 342):

> Ferners soll alle sontagnachmittag zu der stund, die einem jeden ort gelegen ist, catechismuspredigt also gehalten werden, daß der kirchendiener fürs erst nach dem gesang das vaterunser bete und Gott umb rechten verstand seins worts anrufe, darnach die zehen gebot verstendtlich dem volck fürlese. Darauf soll er die angehenden, welche die fragen, so gepredigt werden, noch nit lernen können, verhören und ordenlich erstlich ein zeit lang auf die text, darnach auch allgemach auf die fragstück anleiten. Nach disem lasse er etliche under der jugend ein gewisse anzal fragen im catechismo (wie wir dann denselben umb dieser ursach willen in Sontage theilen haben lassen), so in vorgehenden und sonderlich in der nechsten predigt erkläret worden und sie zuvor in der schul oder daheim gelernet, aufsagen. Und wann

> dise also in beysein der gemein von etlichen aufgesagt worden, soll der kirchendiener etliche folgende fragen einfeltig und kürtzlich erklären und außlegen, also das er den catechismum zum wenigsten einmal alle jar außpredige.

Further, every Sunday afternoon, at the hour that is convenient for each place, the catechism sermon shall be held thus: that the minister of the church first, after the hymn, pray the Our Father and call upon God for the right understanding of his word, and thereafter read the Ten Commandments understandably to the people. Thereupon he shall hear the beginners, who cannot yet learn the questions that are preached, and lead them in order, first for a time to the texts, and thereafter by little and little to the questions also. After this let him have certain among the youth say off a set number of questions in the catechism (as we have for this cause had the same divided into Sundays), which have been explained in the foregoing and especially in the last sermon, and which they have learned beforehand in the school or at home. And when these have thus been said off by some in the presence of the congregation, the minister shall explain and expound certain following questions simply and briefly, so that he preach out the catechism at the least once every year.

The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) kept this plan but timed it: in the towns, a first afternoon service with prayer, the summary and the texts of the five chief parts, "some questions … expounded for half an hour", the examination and blessing; and a second towards evening for "the old and grown", more fully. In the villages the youth were examined "when the second bell hath been rung", and the third bell then called the whole congregation to the half-hour sermon (Sehling 14, p. 558).

**Classes and the doors shut: Hanau, 1609.** The Hanau order of catechisation (Reformed) divided the young into five classes, boys from six to sixteen and girls under fourteen: the Our Father, the Creed, the Ten Commandments, all five chief parts, and the five parts with the added questions and the graces at table and the morning and evening prayers (Sehling 10, p. 487). In the villages the pastor began "with the customary prayer and hymn", read the five chief parts and the questions from the pulpit, and gave a short exposition. Then "pastor, schoolmaster and bell-ringer" heard the classes. After a closing prayer the congregation and children went home, but those summoned stayed behind, men and women, sons and daughters each in their place, "and the church doors also shut", and the pastor read the questions to them "slowly, clearly and distinctly", they repeating "quietly", until they knew them (Sehling 10, p. 491).

**Emden: the great catechism and the examination of the little ones.** In Micron's order (Reformed) the Sunday catechism sermon on the great catechism was interrupted for the examination of the young children twice a year. **Emden, Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 606):

> Und diß examen geschicht allezeit des Sontags offentlich zur zeit der erklärung des grossen catechismi, wann der diener ein halbe stund gepredigt hat. Wenn alle diese fragen und antwort geschehen sind und der diener ein vermanung zu den eltern derselbigen getan hat, daß sie also fortfaren, ihre kinder in der forcht des Herren aufzuziehen, so vermanet der diener die ganze gemeine zur danksagung und betet also

And this examination is held always on the Sunday, openly, at the time of the explanation of the great catechism, when the minister hath preached half an hour. When all these questions and answers are done, and the minister hath made an exhortation to the parents of the same, that they so continue to bring up their children in the fear of the Lord, then the minister exhorteth the whole congregation to thanksgiving, and prayeth thus.

The thanksgiving begins "O gracious Father, who out of the mouth of young children and sucklings preparest thy praise", and asks that God "would so strengthen and govern these our children with thy Holy Spirit" that they walk "in the ways of truth" (Sehling 7/1, p. 606).

### 10.10.7 The ordo compared

**Key.** H = hymn; P = prayer or Our Father; T = text of the chief parts said or read; R = recitation by children; X = exposition or sermon; E = examination; C = collect or closing prayer; B = blessing; V = set within Vespers.

| Order | Vol., p. | Time | Ordo | Length |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg town, 1533 | 1, pp. 700–701 | Sunday early | X, T, exhortation to prayer | — |

| Order | Vol., p. | Time | Ordo | Length |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537 | 2, p. 72 | Sunday Vespers (V) | *Te Deum*, epistle, R, H, X (alternate years), *Magnificat*, C, *Benedicamus* | — |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1543 | 17/1, pp. 162–163 | Sunday 6 or 7 a.m. | Kyrie and Gloria, P, gospel and common place, E (pairs), H, prayer for children, B; alternate Sundays X | — |
| Nördlingen, 1544 | 12, p. 319 | Sunday midday | H, R (text, then with exposition), H, X, H, C, B | — |
| Mecklenburg, 1552 (Lüneburg 1564; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569; Oldenburg 1573) | 5, p. 200 | Sunday 1 p.m. | H, E, *Magnificat*, T, X, *Nunc dimittis*, C, *Benedicamus* | — |
| Württemberg, 1553 | 16, pp. 243, 246 | Sunday, set locally | X, E, prayer for the children | — |
| Sangerhausen, 1555 | 1, p. 658 | Sunday 1 p.m. (V) | Latin psalm, responsory, H, lesson, H, X, H, E at the altar, *Verleih uns Frieden*, C | — |
| Neckarbischofsheim, 1560 | 16, p. 672 | Sunday 12 noon | bell, H, X, T, R, T (next part), E, P, H, B | — |
| Rostock, *Conformitas*, c. 1560 | 5, p. 289 | Sunday 12 noon | psalms from 11; X; P; psalm | X ≤ 1 hour |
| Palatinate, 1563 (Reformed) | 14, p. 342 | Sunday afternoon | H, P, T (Decalogue), beginners heard, R (Sunday portion), X | catechism yearly |
| Emden (Micron), 1565 (Reformed) | 7/1, p. 606 | Sunday | X (great catechism), E of little children twice a year, exhortation, thanksgiving | X ½ hour |
| Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 251–253 | Sunday afternoon | psalm, catechism hymn, T, X (two parts), E, psalm, B | E about ½ hour |
| Sulzfeld, 1566 | 2, p. 353 | Sunday Vespers (V) | psalm, H, R, *Te Deum*, T, E, X, *Magnificat*, C, *Benedicamus* | — |
| Lippe, 1571 (Oldenburg 1573) | 21, p. 397 | Sunday 1 p.m., villages | bell, catechism hymn, T, X by question and answer, E | — |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574 | 18, p. 523 | Sunday 1 or 2 p.m. | H, P, E with R, psalm, T, X, P, H, B | — |
| Thorn, 1575 | 4, pp. 236–239 | Sunday Vespers (V); Monday 2 or 3 p.m. | X between hymn and *Magnificat*; Monday E; daily T and X at Matins and Vespers | X about ½ hour |
| Penig, 1575 | 1, p. 634 | Sunday Vespers (V) | *Magnificat*, T, X, R, H, C, B | catechism by Advent |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588 | 10, p. 627 | Sunday afternoon | H, catechism hymn, T, X, P, E, H, P, B | — |

| Order | Vol., p. | Time | Ordo | Length |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hohenlohe, 1596 | 15, p. 663 | Sunday | H, P, T, X read, E, summary, H, P, B | whole ≤ 1 hour |
| Palatinate, 1601 (Reformed) | 14, p. 558 | Sunday afternoon; villages at the 2nd bell | H, P, T, X, E, P, B | X ½ hour |
| Solms-Laubach, 1603 | 9, p. 357 | Saturday Vespers (V) | psalm, R, *Magnificat*, P, *Benedicamus* | — |
| Hanau, 1609 (Reformed) | 10, pp. 487, 491 | Sunday, villages | P, H, T, X, E in five classes, P; adults kept back | — |

## 10.11 Ceremonial in the offices and the catechism service

Several matters touching the body are treated elsewhere:

- the short *preces* said kneeling after the gospel canticle: §10.7.5 above;
- the chant, the psalm tones and the lesson tones: §§10.9.1–10.9.3 above;
- the cope and the surplice: Chapter 14, §§14.7.2, 14.7.4;
- lights on the altar: Chapter 14, §14.5.4;
- gestures at the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15.

This section gathers what the orders prescribe for the body at Matins, Vespers, the Litany and the catechism service.

### 10.11.1 What the orders say, and what they do not

**The searches.** The corpus was searched, near the words for the offices (*Mette*, *Vesper*, *horae*, *Complet*, *Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Litanei*, *Catechismus*, *Kinderlehre*), for the same families of gesture as at the Mass (Chapter 2, §2.15.1): kneeling and *flexis genibus*; bowing; standing and sitting; hats and bare heads; the hands; turning toward the altar or the people; the sign of the cross; the kiss; incense.

**What the orders prescribe.** The rubrics for the offices are fewer even than for the Mass. Where the orders say anything, it is one of five things:

- **kneeling to pray**: for the *preces*, the closing collects, the *Da pacem* and the *Veni sancte Spiritus* (§10.11.2);
- **kneeling before the altar for the Litany**: two, three or four boys, the choir and the people answering (§10.11.3);
- **two choirs facing**: the psalms sung or said "verse about verse" from stalls set opposite (§10.11.5);
- **the place of the reader**: the pulpit, the lectern, or before the altar (§10.11.6);
- **the children set in order** for the catechism: in pairs facing one another, standing on stools or in the middle of the church, boys on the men's side and girls on the women's (§10.11.7).

**Not found.** No order in the corpus prescribes any of the following for the office:

- a bow at the *Gloria Patri*, at the name of Jesus, or at the *Gloria* of the hymn. The Mecklenburg convents repeat "Ehre sei gott dem vater" after every psalm and canticle, but say nothing of the head (§10.11.5);
- standing for the gospel canticles, or the sign of the cross at the *Benedictus*, *Magnificat* or *Nunc dimittis*;
- the officiant's hat or biretta, or a rule for covering and uncovering the head in choir;
- incense at the *Magnificat* or *Benedictus*, or the censing of the altar at Vespers;
- genuflection, the hands joined or raised, or a turn toward the people at *Dominus vobiscum* in the office.

The sign of the cross appears only at the household morning and evening blessings (§10.11.8).

### 10.11.2 Kneeling to pray

**After the gospel canticle.** The Bugenhagen orders have the children kneel for the short *preces* after the *Magnificat* and *Benedictus* (§10.7.5). **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 463), at the evening office in Our Lady's church:

> Na dem Sermone schal de Scholemester anheven dat Magnificat, Darna Da pacem Domine Edder Veni Sancte spiritus. Na der Antiphen lathe me de kinder up de knee vallen unde seggen: Kyrie eleyson, Christe eleyson, Kyrie eleyson. Pater noster.

After the sermon the schoolmaster shall begin the *Magnificat*, thereafter *Da pacem Domine* or *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. After the antiphon let the children fall upon their knees and say: *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison. Pater noster.*

**At the opening and the close of Vespers.** The Pomeranian *Agenda* has the school kneel twice at the Saturday and eve Vespers: for the opening invocation of the Spirit, and for the *Da pacem* after the *Benedicamus*. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 435):

> Erstlick singet men flexis genibus: Veni sancte spiritus; edder den ersten vers: Veni creator spiritus; edder Adesto deus unus etc., edder wat süs pro tempore evenkömlick is […] Dar na lest de prester eine collecte düdisch edder latinisch, unde beslüt dat chor mit dem benedicamus, unde singet dar up, da pacem domine, flexis genibus, latinisch edder düdisch.

First they sing on bended knees: *Veni sancte Spiritus*; or the first verse, *Veni creator Spiritus*; or *Adesto Deus unus*, etc., or whatsoever else is meet for the season […] Thereafter the priest readeth a collect in German or Latin, and the choir concludeth with the *Benedicamus*, and singeth thereupon *Da pacem Domine* on bended knees, in Latin or in German.

**The other kneeling places.**

- **Schönburg 1542, Matins.** After the *Te Deum* or canticle the boys say "flexis genibus" the prayers against the Turk, *Da pacem*, and the *preces pro serenitate* or *pro pluvia*, with a versicle and collect (Sehling 2, p. 170).
- **Regensburg 1567, Vespers.** After the deacon's German collect, "etliche knaben, für dem altar knieend", sing the *Benedicamus Domino*, and the choir answers *Deo gratias* (Sehling 13, p. 461).
- **Stolberg-Königstein 1552, the morning lesson.** After the German psalms the preacher shall "mit Andacht und gantz kniendt" sing or read three German collects: for forgiveness, for wisdom in government, and for peace (Sehling 9, p. 468).

**The Reformed morning and evening prayer.** The Palatinate order of 1563 (Reformed) bids the congregation kneel at the opening of its daily prayers. **Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 396), the morning prayer:

> Geliebten in dem herrn Jesu Christo, lasset uns vor dem angesicht Gottes niderknien und in auß grund unsers hertzen also anrufen

Beloved in the Lord Jesus Christ, let us kneel down before the face of God, and call upon him from the ground of our hearts on this wise.

The evening prayer opens in the same words (Sehling 14, p. 397). The Palatinate order of 1601 (Reformed) reprints both prayers but changes "niderknien" to "demütigen", "humble ourselves" (Sehling 14, p. 572, nn. 12, 15). In East Frisia the editor's note on the Lütetsburg order of 1606 (Reformed) quotes its morning prayer in Low German: "latet uns vor dem angesichte Gades nedderkneen" (Sehling 7/1, p. 541).

### 10.11.3 The Litany: boys kneeling before the altar

The Litany was the one office the orders regularly order to be sung kneeling. The visitors in Mecklenburg wanted the people on their knees for it after the Sunday sermon. **Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542** (Sehling 5, p. 149):

> Zum dritten soll der pastor am sontage nach der predigte in stetten und dorfern die letanei dem volke vom predigstuel mit andacht fursingen und die schuler oder der kuster samt dem volke sollen niderkniegen und ime darauf antwurten.

Thirdly, the pastor shall on Sunday after the sermon, in towns and villages, devoutly sing the Litany before the people from the pulpit, and the scholars or the sexton, together with the people, shall kneel down and answer him.

The usual form is a small group of boys kneeling before the altar, with the choir and the people answering. **Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 2, p. 134), on the weekday preaching days:

> Auf dieser tage einem in der wochen, wen die predigt aus ist, pflegt man die litanei zu singen, das ist gemeine gebet für allerlei not und für alle stende des ganzen christenthums. Drei knaben sind mit weissen chorröcken angethan, knien fur dem altar und singen den ersten chor. Die schulknaben und die gemein versamlung antworten und singen den andern chor.

On one of these days in the week, when the sermon is ended, they are wont to sing the Litany, that is, the common prayer for all manner of need and for all estates of the whole of Christendom. Three boys, clad in white surplices, kneel before the altar and sing the first choir. The schoolboys and the common assembly answer and sing the second choir.

The same arrangement appears elsewhere:

- **Cologne, the prayer-day order of 1546** (Moderate Reformed): three or four boys "vor eynen altar knyende" begin the Litany, and the whole choir with the pastor, chaplains and priests answers (Sehling 22, p. 45).
- **Waldeck 1556**: "etliche der Schüler oder der Pfarrherr, vor dem Altar niderkniend" (Sehling 9, p. 277).
- **Marggrabowa 1581**: every Friday, "zwen oder drei knaben furm altar knien", Luther's Litany "and not in rhyme" (Sehling 4, p. 149).
- **Isny c. 1600**: the minister bids, "Laßt uns auff knien und der Christlichen kirchen christliche Lytanei also mit ainandern sprechen und beten" (Sehling 17/1, p. 468).

The forms of the Litany and who sang it are treated in Chapter 13, §13.22.3.

#### 10.11.4 Kneeling at the evening bell

Kneeling was not confined to the church. During the plague of 1585 the Breslau council asked the people to pray at the evening bell as the morning congregation already did in church. **Breslau, notice of the council concerning the plague, 1585** (Sehling 3, p. 405):

> Erstlich, weil allezeit in dieser fährlichen zeit des morgends ein guter teil des volks beim kirchgebet und lektion sich sehen lassen, dass sie auch dergleichen auf den abend, wenn man pro pace leutet, da die arbeiter von ihrer arbeit pflegen abzugehen, herwiderum ein abendgebet und liedlein im hause und die, so auf der gassen gehen, knieende beten wollen

Firstly, forasmuch as in this perilous time a good part of the people hath ever shown itself of a morning at the church prayer and lesson, that they would likewise in the evening, when the bell is rung *pro pace*, at which time the labourers are wont to go from their work, in turn pray an evening prayer and a little hymn in the house; and those that are going in the street, that they would pray kneeling.

The evening bell itself, and the prayer for peace that replaced the Ave Maria, are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.3.

#### 10.11.5 Two choirs facing

The psalms were sung by two sides of the choir, verse about verse. Only the Mecklenburg convent order says how the singers stand. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 258), for the nuns' Matins:

> Darnach folgen die psalmen, so uf einen jeglichen tag in vorgesetzten calendario verzeichnet sein, welche die jungfrauen, jede in ihrem stuhl gegeneinander über, einen vers üm den andern beten oder singen sollen, und zu ende eines jeglichen psalmen, dergleichen auch der lobgesänge (benedictus, magnificat, benedicite, nunc dimittis) den vers: Ehre sei gott dem vater und dem sohn und dem heiligen geiste widerholen.

Thereafter follow the psalms which are appointed for every day in the calendar set before, which the maidens, each in her stall, over against one another, shall pray or sing one verse about the other; and at the end of every psalm, and likewise of the canticles (*Benedictus*, *Magnificat*, *Benedicite*, *Nunc dimittis*), they shall repeat the verse: Glory be to God the Father and to the Son and to the Holy Ghost.

The same two sides served for the catechism. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 703):

> Fur der fruepredigt des sontags oder feststagen sollen die knaben im chor den catechismum lateinisch auf beiden seiten vers umb vers sine tono distincto ganz auslesen

Before the early sermon on Sundays or feast days the boys shall read the whole catechism through in Latin in the choir, on both sides, verse about verse, *sine tono*, distinctly.

#### 10.11.6 The place of the lesson

The orders name the place from which the office lesson is read, but not the reader's posture:

- **Coburg 1545**: at Vespers the chapter of the Old Testament is read in German by the priest "auf dem predigstuel oder mittelaltar, nachdeme vil oder wenig volks vorhanden", from the pulpit or the middle altar, as many or few people are present. On weekdays the epistle and gospel are read "von dem altar auf einem pult" (Sehling 1, p. 543).
- **Herpf 1566**: at the Saturday evening prayer the chapter is read "vor dem altar" (Sehling 2, p. 334).
- **Schweinfurt 1543**: one boy, or two or three if the chapter is long, read the Latin lesson; the chaplain then reads it in German "zum volk", toward the people (Sehling 11, p. 631).
- **Wittenberg 1533**: three boys read three lessons at Saturday Vespers "nach dem tono, wie man lectiones pflegt zu lesen", the last words sung (Sehling 1, p. 703).

#### 10.11.7 The catechism service: the children set in order

The catechism service has more stage directions than any office. Five things recur: the minister goes to the altar; the children come out from their places; they are set in pairs facing one another; they stand up, sometimes on stools, to recite; and boys and girls are kept apart.

**Facing pairs.** The earliest full direction is Schönburg's weekday catechism. **Schönburg lordships, church order of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 174):

> Tritt der priester für den altar und betet die 6 hauptstücke der christl. lehre, wie droben geschrieben vom wort zu wort, und alle, so in der kirchen sind. 3. Darnach treten 3 knaben und 3 gegen einander über ins gesichte etwas höher denn die andern und fragen einander dialogen weise.

The priest goeth before the altar and prayeth the six chief parts of Christian doctrine, as is written above, word for word, and all that are in the church with him. 3. Thereafter three boys and three step forth over against one another, face to face, somewhat higher than the rest, and question one another by way of dialogue.

At the end the priest goes back "vor das altar" and prays the six parts once more for the children (Sehling 2, p. 174).

**Standing on stools. Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 464), the Wednesday catechism:

> Auf dasselbig stehen dann zween knaben auf stulen, darzu gegeneinander bereitet, deren einer fragt, der ander antwortet und erzelet fein langsam, deudlich und klerlich mit lauter stimme den bloßen text des ganzen catechismi von allen 6 stücken. Nach diesem stehen auf andere zween

Thereupon two boys stand up upon stools set over against one another for the purpose, of whom the one asketh and the other answereth, and reciteth right slowly, plainly and clearly, with a loud voice, the bare text of the whole catechism, of all six parts. After this two others stand up.

About five pairs are set up in turn.

**Boys on the men's side, girls on the women's. Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Count Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 311), after the catechism sermon:

> Auf dieses vom predigstuel fur den altar gehen, und dann der schulmeister mit sampt dem chor oder der ganzen kirchen das letzte gesetze aus dem deutschen gesange Ein feste burg (Preis ehr und lob) singen, darunter denn die gemeine jugend aus irem orte, da sie zuvor gestanden, mitten in die kirchen, die knaben auf der menner, die megdlein aber auf der weiber seiten sich stellen.

Upon this [the preacher shall] go from the pulpit before the altar, and then the schoolmaster with the choir or the whole church shall sing the last stanza of the German hymn *Ein feste Burg* ("Preis, Ehr und Lob"); during which the common youth shall go from the place where they stood before into the middle of the church, and set themselves, the boys on the men's side and the maidens on the women's side.

Four scholars then step up "an einen bequemen ort, do sie von jederman wol gehöret werden können", and afterward return "in züchtiger stille zum chor" (Sehling 2, p. 311).

**Two choirs of children. Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 692):

> Es werden aber in den vorerzelten Classibus oder Unterscheiden des Catechismi allezeit die Knaben und Töchtern, welche gleich weit im Lehrnen kommen, gegen einandern uber gleich als in zwen Chöre gestellet.

But in the aforesaid classes or divisions of the catechism the boys and daughters which are come equally far in learning are always set over against one another, as it were in two choirs.

Each child who has recited receives "ein newer Straßburger Pfenning", a new Strasbourg penny, and those who know the whole catechism with the table of duties and the psalms or hymns "ein newer Kreutzer" (Sehling 20/1, p. 692). The children are to answer "fein laut und verständtlich" and, while others recite, to listen "still und züchtig" and repeat everything silently.

**Kneeling with folded hands.** Heilbronn asks for a posture of prayer from the children called out to pray. **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 315):

> Unnd sollen die jungen knaben auß der lateynischen schul lateynische, unnd die auß der teutschen schul teutsche, von dem diacon allweg ettwan zween oder drew erfordert werden, die mit andacht, knieend, mit zusamen gelegten henden betten sollen

And the young boys out of the Latin school [shall pray] Latin, and those out of the German school German [prayers]; two or three at a time shall be called forth by the deacon, which shall pray devoutly, kneeling, with folded hands.

This is the only place in the corpus where the hands of those praying in an office or catechism service are prescribed.

**The rest.**

- **Pairs.** The children are set "ye par und par" to ask one another the questions at the early Sunday catechism in Schwäbisch Hall (1543; Sehling 17/1, p. 162). The Württemberg order for the German schools (1559) sets them "Knaben gegen Knaben, Metlin gegen Metlin, gegen einander", boys against boys and girls against girls, in school, so that they may recite "in der Kirchen zu zeit des Catechismi auch offentlich vor der Gemein" (Sehling 17/1, p. 584). At Rothenberg (1618) the schoolboys recite the table of duties "mit fragen und antwort gegen einander" (Sehling 13, p. 548).
- **Stepping out.** At Schweinfurt (1543) "sollen auch die schuler gegen einander auftreten", only those "die gut sprache und stark ausreden haben"; the shy are to be heard in school, "sonst … wurde zuletzt ein spot daraus" (Sehling 11, p. 642).
- **Standing or kneeling at the altar.** In the Schillingsfürst order (before 1578), "nach der collecten stehen die kinder oder knien zum altar" and repeat the chief parts after the pastor (Sehling 15, p. 227). In Hohenlohe (1596) the pastor, after hearing some children, is "widerumb für dem altar stehen" to repeat the main points of the sermon (Sehling 15, p. 663).
- **A girl leads.** In the Torgau girls' school (1575), after the morning blessing and the *Veni creator*, "teglichen ein megdlein aufstehen", one girl stands up every day and prays the five parts aloud for the others to repeat (Sehling 1, p. 685).

#### 10.11.8 The sign of the cross: at home, not in choir

No office or catechism service in the corpus prescribes the sign of the cross in church. It survives in the morning and evening blessings of Luther's Small Catechism, the household office, and there the orders divide.

**Kept and defended.** The Kurland order asks the households to keep the morning and evening blessing with the sign. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 91):

> jederman, sonderlich die jungen kinder, zum morgen und abentsegen gehalten werden, und dasselbig ohne verachtung des heiligen creuzes zeichens, welche ohne jenige superstition seind signa fidei, religionis et confessionis nostrae, der christen pannier und veldzeichen.

Every man, and especially the young children, shall be held to the morning and evening blessing, and that without contempt of the sign of the holy cross, which signs are, without any superstition, *signa fidei, religionis et confessionis nostrae*, the banner and ensign of Christians.

**Printed in the catechism.** The Palatinate order of 1556 prints Luther's rubric whole: "soltu dich segnen mit dem heiligen creutz und sagen: Das walt Gott, vater, sohn und heiliger geist, Amen. Darauf sprich kniend oder stehend den glauben oder vaterunser" (Sehling 14, p. 141).

**Struck out.** Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557) prints "soltu dich segnen und sagen"; the editor notes that the draft read "mit dem heyligen creütz" and that it was struck (Sehling 18, p. 179, n. u). Nördlingen (1579) likewise has only "solt du dich segnen und also sagen" (Sehling 12, p. 357).

### 10.11.9 Summary by order

| Order | Office or service | What is prescribed | Sehling |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg 1533 | Sunday catechism; Saturday Vespers | catechism read "auf beiden seiten vers umb vers"; lessons by three boys | 1, p. 703 |
| Bremen 1534 | evening office | children kneel for the *preces* after the antiphon | 7/2.2, p. 463 |
| Schönburg 1542 | Matins; weekday catechism | *flexis genibus* for the prayers; priest before the altar; boys face to face, raised | 2, pp. 170, 174 |
| Mecklenburg 1542 | Litany after the Sunday sermon | scholars and people kneel and answer | 5, p. 149 |
| Heilbronn 1543 | catechism after Vespers | boys pray kneeling with folded hands | 17/1, p. 315 |
| Schwäbisch Hall 1543 | Sunday catechism | children set in pairs | 17/1, p. 162 |
| Schweinfurt 1543 | Vespers; catechism | lesson read "zum volk"; good speakers step out facing | 11, pp. 631, 642 |
| Coburg 1545 | Vespers | lesson from pulpit or middle altar | 1, p. 543 |
| Cologne 1546 (Moderate Reformed) | Litany on prayer days | boys kneel before an altar | 22, p. 45 |
| Stolberg-Königstein 1552 | morning lesson | three collects sung kneeling | 9, p. 468 |
| Waldeck 1556 | Litany after the sermon | scholars or pastor kneel before the altar | 9, p. 277 |
| Palatinate 1556 | household blessing | sign of the cross; creed kneeling or standing | 14, p. 141 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557 | household blessing | cross struck from the draft | 18, p. 179 |
| Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) | morning and evening prayer | "lasset uns … niderknien" | 14, pp. 396–397 |
| Herpf 1566 | Saturday evening prayer | chapter read before the altar | 2, p. 334 |
| Regensburg 1567 | Vespers; Wednesday catechism | boys kneel before the altar for *Benedicamus*; pairs stand on stools | 13, pp. 461, 464 |
| Pomerania 1569 | Saturday Vespers | *Veni sancte Spiritus* and *Da pacem flexis genibus* | 4, p. 435 |
| Kurland 1570 | household blessing | sign of the cross defended | 5, p. 91 |
| Mecklenburg convents 1572 | Matins | nuns in stalls facing, verse about verse | 5, p. 258 |
| Schwarzburg 1574 | Litany | three boys in surplices kneel before the altar | 2, p. 134 |
| Torgau 1575 | girls' school | one girl stands and leads | 1, p. 685 |

| Order | Office or service | What is prescribed | Sehling |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nördlingen 1579 | household blessing | no cross | 12, p. 357 |
| Marggrabowa 1581 | Friday Litany | two or three boys kneel before the altar | 4, p. 149 |
| Henneberg 1582 | catechism | youth into the middle of the church, boys and girls apart | 2, p. 311 |
| Breslau 1585 | evening bell | prayer kneeling in the street | 3, p. 405 |
| Hohenlohe 1596 | catechism | pastor stands before the altar | 15, p. 663 |
| Strasbourg 1598 | catechism | children "in zwen Chöre"; a penny for reciting | 20/1, p. 692 |
| Isny c. 1600 | Litany | "Laßt uns auff knien" | 17/1, p. 468 |
| Palatinate 1601 (Reformed) | morning and evening prayer | "demütigen" for "niderknien" | 14, p. 572 |
| Lütetsburg 1606 (Reformed) | morning prayer | "nedderkneen" | 7/1, p. 541 |
| Rothenberg 1618 | catechism | table of duties recited facing | 13, p. 548 |

## 10.12 Table by order

**Key.**

- **Hours**: which offices the order provides.
  - "All" = Matins (with Lauds), Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers, Compline.
  - "M+V" = morning and evening offices.
- **Who**: the singers.
- **Lang.**: L = Latin; G = German or Low German; L/G = both.
- **?**: not stated.

| Order | Vol. | Hours | Who | Lang. | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523 | 1 | M+V daily; Mass and Vespers on Sunday | priests, scholars, future preachers; all on Sunday | ? | Bible in course with exposition; one hour each |
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1 | All, shortened (3 psalms) | boys; "episcopus" orders | L | daily lessons with vernacular exposition |
| Wittenberg castle church, 1525 | 1 | All; Vespers + Compline joined | ministers of the foundation | L | Gospels at little hours; no *Deus in adiutorium*, no *preces* |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | M+V daily in towns with schools | boys | L, lesson repeated in G | |
| Braunschweig 1528; Hamburg 1529; Lübeck 1531 | 6/1; 5 | M+V daily (Compline folded in on feasts) | school, cantor | L, lesson in G | half an hour; octonary of Ps 119 |

| Order | Vol. | Hours | Who | Lang. | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nimbschen convent, 1529 | 1 | Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext on feasts | nuns | ? | |
| Torgau, 1529 | 1 | "private hours" | altarists (formerly schoolmasters) | ? | |
| Ansbach *Gottesdienstmandat* 1531; *Ordnung bei den Stiften* 1533 | 11 | All | canons | L | OT in course at Matins; *preces* dropped |
| Remse convent, 1533 | 1 | M+V in place of the hours | nuns | G | three psalms, chapter, canticle, collect |
| Altenburg castle chapter, 1533 | 1 | All, one nocturn | canons | L | Litany for *preces* |
| Wittenberg town, 1533 | 1 | M+V; Saturday and Sunday Vespers | boys; people at Te Deum | L (G only with the people) | prophecy cadence; *Nunc dimittis* figural |
| Goslar, St Simon and Judas, 1534 | 7/2.2 | All | canons | L | not reduced |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4 | M+V in parishes | boys | L | "enough for the parish churches" |
| Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio*, 1535 (Denmark 1537; Schleswig-Holstein 1542; Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543) | 4; 23; 6/1 | All | remaining monks and canons | L | Bible twice a year; Compline recited |
| Lippe 1538; Mecklenburg 1552 | 21; 5 | chapters "not burdened" | — | — | preaching in their place |
| Leipzig friaries and convents, 1539 | 1 | "seven hours" *de tempore* | friars (doors locked), religious | ? | |
| Brandenburg, 1540 | 3 | All, "nothing omitted" *de tempore* | chapters, convents, parishes | L | diocesan Breviary, old choir books |
| Stendal 1540; Cölln 1540; Salzwedel 1541 | 3 | hours *de tempore* daily | vicars and beneficed priests | L | on pain of losing the benefice |
| Naumburg cathedral, c. 1541–1543 | 2 | All | chapter, scholars, people | L, lesson in G | German chapter and people's psalm |
| Spandau convent, 1541 | 3 | Matins, Prime, Terce, Sext, None | nuns | ? | Breviary corrected; catechism in refectory |
| Crevese convent, 1541 | 3 | Hours *de tempore*; Litany after Prime | nuns | ? | Litany Sunday, Monday, Wednesday, Friday |
| Calenberg convents, 1542 | 6/2 | All; Lauds Sundays only | nuns | ? | |

| Order | Vol. | Hours | Who | Lang. | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Frankenberg convent, 1542 | 7/2.2 | Matins, little hours etc., "in place of the hours" | nuns, voluntary | L | |
| Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*, 1542 | 4 | Saturday and eve Vespers | boys, chaplain | L | Latin Litany for the *Magnificat* in Advent and Lent; *Da pacem* |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543; Heidelberg 1546 | 13; 14 | All, where customary | chapters, convents, parishes | L; G lessons in parishes; G psalmody for nuns | nine lessons in course |
| Quakenbrück (Bonnus), 1543 | 7/1 | All | canons, scholars | L | |
| Merseburg synod, 1544 | 2 | — | pastors | — | exhorted to daily prayer and psalter |
| Zwickau, 1545 | 1 | hospital hours abolished | preacher with the poor | G | psalm and lesson daily |
| Lüneburg convents, 1555 | 6/1 | All | nuns | L | corrected Breviary (*Emendatio*) |
| Senftenberg, 1555 | 1 | M+V daily; Sunday Matins | school | L, lesson in G | German responsory |
| Öhringen chapter, 1556 | 15 | All | canons | L | |
| Breslau, 1557 (report) | 3 | hours of the Passion; Friday hours of the Visitation | choralists | L | |
| Württemberg cloister schools, 1559 | 16 | *preces*; morning and evening office | students | L | psalter in course; *Benedictus* / *Quicunque* alternately |
| Tübingen Stipendium, 1559 | 17/1 | morning and evening psalms | stipendiaries | ? | psalter recited in course |
| Mecklenburg, *Conformitas*, c. 1560 | 5 | — | choir | — | Lossius's *Psalmodia* required |
| Feuchtwangen chapter, 1563 | 11 | Matins and Lauds daily; little hours lapsed, then one a day | canons | L | psalter monthly |
| Prussia, 1568 | 4 | Saturday, Sunday and weekday Vespers | boys; village pastors | L, lesson in G; G in villages | boys learn to speak before the people |
| Pomerania *Agenda*, 1569 | 4 | Vespers | school, organist | L/G | organ alternation |

| Order | Vol. | Hours | Who | Lang. | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Keppel convent (Nassau), 1570 | 10 | All | nuns, taught by the preacher | G | Leipzig psalm-books with notes |
| Mecklenburg convents, 1572 | 5 | daily office in place of the hours | nuns, domina in turn | G | German *preces* daily; psalter monthly, OT yearly, NT thrice |
| Lippe 1571; Oldenburg 1573 | 21; 7/2.1 | Vespers in villages; summer Matins | pastor, sexton, boys, people | G | |
| Oldenburg, 1573 | 7/2.1 | Vespers | school, organist | L/G | Spangenberg or Lossius required |
| Lüneburg convents, 1574 | 6/1 | All | nuns | L/G | 3 Latin + 1 German psalm at Matins |
| Pfalz-Neuburg *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13 | Saturday and feast-eve Vespers | pastor | ? | even "if no one came" |
| Saxony, 1580 | 1 | Saturday Vespers, Sunday Matins; weekday M+V in great towns | Latin school; then German school | L; G (weekday) | |
| Hoya, 1581 | 6/2 | Sunday Vespers | school, organist | L/G | sermon inside Vespers |
| Leeden convent, 1585 | 22 | morning prayer daily | conventuals with pastor | ? | psalm, chapter, exposition |
| Lohr (Rieneck), 1588 | 11 | First Vespers of Sundays and feasts | youth | L | Lossius; psalms explained in school |
| Hof, 1592 | 11 | Vespers; daily early service | scholars, boys and girls | L/G | figural option; German *Magnificat* tone 6 |
| Verden cathedral, 1606 | 7/1 | Matins and Vespers on Saturdays, Sundays, feasts | cathedral choir | L | "as the old order bringeth with it" |

## 10.13 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523 | 1, pp. 2–3 | 2 | 10.3.1, 10.6.4 |
| Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523 | 1, p. 9 | 2 | 10.3.2 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, pp. 13–14 | 3 | 10.3.3, 10.8.1, 10.10.1 |
| Ernestine Saxony, deliberations for the visitation (Sehling's introduction) | 1, p. 38 | 6 | 10.4.1 |
| Wittenberg, *Wie es einer zeit mit den ceremonien der kirchen gehalten wirt*, 1525 | 1, pp. 698–699 | 147 | 10.4.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.4 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528 | 1, p. 167 | 9 | 10.3.4 |
| Nimbschen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Kloster*, 1529 | 1, p. 617 | 110 | 10.4.4 |
| Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529 | 1, p. 677 | 139 | 10.5.3 |
| Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529 | 1, p. 527 | 63 | 10.7.5 |
| Eilenburg, visitation order, 1529 | 1, p. 560 | 82 | 10.7.5 |
| Niemegk, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529 | 1, p. 616 | 110 | 10.7.5 |
| Kloster Remse, *Ein kurze christliche ordnung in das junkfrau closter*, 1533 | 1, p. 652 | 125 | 10.7.5, 10.8.2 |
| Altenburg, *Verordnung … fur den stift aufm schloss*, 1533 | 1, p. 515 | 56 | 10.4.2, 10.7.5 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533 | 1, pp. 700–705 | 148 | 10.5.2, 10.6.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.9.1, 10.9.3, 10.9.4, 10.10.1, 10.10.7, 10.11.5, 10.11.6 |
| Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537 | 2, p. 72 | 1219 | 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Leipzig, *Visitations-Artikel für die Klöster*; *Gemeines Fürhalten*, 1539 | 1, pp. 589–590 | 97, 98 | 10.4.4 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang* (Duke Henry), 1539 | 1, p. 564 | 85 | 10.5.2 |
| Naumburg, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung in der Domkirche*, 1543 (1541?) | 2, p. 596 | 1265 | 10.4.2, 10.6.4, 10.8.1 |
| Merseburg, synodal decree, 1544 | 2, p. 13 | 1211 | 10.6.5 |
| Zwickau, *Ordenung der pfarren und kirchen*, 1545 | 1, p. 725 | 154 | 10.5.1 |
| Schönburg lordships, church order of Johann Pfeffinger, 1542 | 2, pp. 170, 174 | 1235 | 10.5.3, 10.11.2, 10.11.7 |
| Coburg, *Verordnung und bestellung des kirchendiensts*, 1545 | 1, p. 543 | 73 | 10.7.5, 10.11.6 |
| Senftenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Senftenberg*, 1555 | 1, pp. 671–672 | 136 | 10.5.2, 10.7.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sangerhausen, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1555 | 1, p. 658 | 128 | 10.10.2, 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Obermaßfeld (Henneberg), the pastor's account of his services, 1563 | 2, p. 343 | 1249 | 10.10.2 |
| Sulzfeld and Klein-Bardorf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566 | 2, p. 353 | 1250 | 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Herpf (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566 | 2, p. 334 | 1248 | 10.11.6 |
| Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung*, 1567 | 1, p. 568 | 87 | 10.10.4 |
| Dresden, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung der Kreuzkirche*, 1574 | 1, p. 555 | 78 | 10.7.5 |
| Brandis, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1574 | 1, p. 534 | 67 | 10.10.2 |
| Schwarzburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 2, p. 134 | 1230 | 10.11.3 |
| Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 1, p. 634 | 116 | 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Torgau, visitation order, 1575: the girls' school | 1, p. 685 | 141 | 10.11.7 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 368, 369, 370, 393, 422 | 44 | 10.5.2, 10.5.3, 10.6.5, 10.10.4, 10.10.5 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Count Georg Ernst, 1582 | 2, p. 311 | 1247 | 10.11.7 |

**Franconia, Swabia and the Palatinate**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Gottesdienstmandat*, 1531 | 11, pp. 311–312 | 275 | 10.4.2 |
| Heilbronn, draft *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1532 | 17/1, p. 302 | 778 | 10.7.5 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533 | 11, pp. 313–316 | 276 | 10.4.2, 10.7.1, 10.7.5 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, pp. 171, 206 | 270 | 10.3.4, 10.10.5 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, pp. 77–78 | 386 | 10.4.2, 10.7.2, 10.8.2, 10.8.3, 10.9.1 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, pp. 162–163, 170 | 762 | 10.6.4, 10.10.2, 10.10.5, 10.10.7, 10.11.7 |
| Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, p. 315 | 781 | 10.11.7 |
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 11, pp. 631, 642 | 304 | 10.11.6, 10.11.7 |
| Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544 | 12, p. 319 | 373 | 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545 | 11, p. 504 | 297 | 10.10.2, 10.10.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546 | 14, p. 91 | 470 | 10.4.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, *Übereinkunft der Geistlichen zu Lehre, Zensur und Gottesdienstgestaltung*, 1548 (Moderate Reformed; on the Interim) | 20/1, p. 355 | 1316 | 10.10.5 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* under Justus Jonas, 1553 | 13, p. 421 | 440 | 10.10.4 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16, pp. 243, 246 | 671 | 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Öhringen, *Reformation und Ordnung des Öhringer Stifts*, 1556 | 15, p. 102 | 545 | 10.4.2 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 14, p. 141 | 480 | 10.11.8 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 | 18, p. 179 | 967 | 10.11.8 |
| Rothenburg ob der Tauber, *Kirchenordnung*, 1559 | 11, p. 591 | 301 | 10.3.4 |
| Württemberg, *Ordnung der deutschen Schulen*, 1559 (supplement to vol. 16) | 17/1, p. 584 | 813 | 10.11.7 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 | 13, pp. 461, 464 | 450 | 10.11.2, 10.11.7 |
| Schillingsfürst, *Kirchenordnung* in use until 1578 | 15, p. 227 | 567 | 10.11.7 |
| Württemberg, *Ordnung der Klosterschulen*, 1559 (with the 1582 variants) | 16, pp. 365–367 | 683 | 10.6.6, 10.9.4 |
| Tübingen, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559, statutes (supplement to vol. 16) | 17/1, p. 562 | 813 | 10.6.6 |
| Neckarbischofsheim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1560 | 16, p. 672 | 742 | 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Feuchtwangen, chapter order, 1563 | 11, p. 402 | 293 | 10.5.3, 10.7.1 |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed) | 14, pp. 342, 396–397 | 499, 504 | 10.10.5, 10.10.6, 10.10.7, 10.11.2 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 523 | 1011 | 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, p. 178 | 404 | 10.6.5 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1579 | 12, pp. 357, 375 | 375 | 10.10.5, 10.11.8 |
| Rieneck, *Vesperordnung zu Lohr*, 1588 | 11, p. 699 | 318 | 10.8.1, 10.9.2 |
| Hohenlohe, Weikersheim orders on the daily prayer, 1588 | 15, pp. 538–550 | 604, 605 | 10.6.5 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 422, 429, 450 | 294 | 10.9.2, 10.9.4 |
| Mülhausen, instructions for the schoolmaster and chaplains, 1524 (Sehling's introduction) (Reformed) | 20/2, p. 163 | 1374 | 10.5.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Schul- und Gesangsordnung* of Count Wolfgang, 1596 | 15, p. 663 | 629 | 10.10.2, 10.10.5, 10.10.7, 10.11.7 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, p. 692 | 1344 | 10.11.7 |
| Isny, *Agende*, c. 1600 | 17/1, p. 468 | 800 | 10.11.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (Reformed) | 14, pp. 558, 572 | 515 | 10.10.2, 10.10.6, 10.10.7, 10.11.2 |
| Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610 | 16, p. 616 | 729 | 10.10.2 |
| Rothenberg, *Christliche vereinigung* of the ministers, 1618 | 13, p. 548 | 460 | 10.11.7 |

**Brandenburg, Prussia, Silesia, Pomerania, Mecklenburg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4, pp. 340, 342 | 1856 | 10.5.2, 10.7.5 |
| Pomerania, *Pia ordinatio caeremoniarum*, 1535 | 4, pp. 345–350 | 1857 | 10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.9.1 |
| Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, pp. 71–72 | 1746 | 10.4.2, 10.9.1 |
| Cölln on the Spree, order of 1540 | 3, p. 156 | 1755 | 10.6.2 |
| Stendal, *Verordnung für die übrigen Kirchen*, 1540 | 3, p. 310 | 1784 | 10.6.2 |
| Spandau, *Verordnung für das Kloster*, 1541 | 3, p. 305 | 1783 | 10.4.4, 10.7.5 |
| Salzwedel-Altstadt, *Ordnung und Abschied*, 1541 | 3, p. 267 | 1778 | 10.6.2 |
| Crevese nunnery, recess, 1541 | 3, p. 203 | 1762 | 10.7.5 |
| Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*, 1542 | 4, p. 354 | 1858 | 10.7.5 |
| Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542 | 5, p. 149 | 1921 | 10.11.3 |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, pp. 196, 200 | 1922 | 10.5.1, 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Danzig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 | 4, p. 181 | 1844 | 10.7.5 |
| Breslau, report on the order of the churches, 1557 | 3, pp. 404–405 | 1807 | 10.4.4 |
| Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 | 5, pp. 288, 289 | 1936 | 10.9.2, 10.10.2, 10.10.7 |
| Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569 | 4, pp. 384–385 | 1862 | 10.10.2, 10.10.5 |
| Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572 | 5, pp. 257–259 | 1926 | 10.5.1, 10.7.1, 10.7.5, 10.8.2, 10.11.5 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, pp. 74–75 | 1833 | 10.5.2, 10.6.1, 10.6.4, 10.9.1, 10.9.4 |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4, p. 435 | 1865 | 10.7.5, 10.9.4, 10.11.2 |
| Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, pp. 83, 91 | 1907 | 10.6.4, 10.11.8 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 4, pp. 236–239 | 1844 | 10.7.5, 10.10.2, 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Salzwedel (Altstadt), visitation recess, 1579 | 3, p. 272 | 1779 | 10.7.5 |
| Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581 | 4, p. 149 | 1837 | 10.11.3 |
| Breslau, notice of the council concerning the plague, 1585 | 3, p. 405 | 1807 | 10.11.4 |

**Lower Saxony, Westphalia, Hesse-Nassau and the North**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 6/1, pp. 399–401 | 1983 | 10.5.2, 10.7.3, 10.7.5, 10.8.1, 10.9.1 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 493, 523 | 1958, 1960 | 10.5.1, 10.7.5 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 | 5, p. 348 | 1949 | 10.7.5 |
| Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 21, p. 170 | 1442 | 10.5.1 |
| Goslar, *Ordnung für das Stundengebet am Stift St. Simon und Judas*, 1534 (and Sehling's introduction) | 7/2.2, pp. 199, 263–264 | 2183, 2194 | 10.4.2, 10.7.5, 10.8.1 |
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 | 7/2.2, pp. 458, 463 | 2217 | 10.7.5, 10.11.2 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1538 | 21, p. 343 | 1459 | 10.5.1 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Klosterordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, p. 851 | 2037 | 10.4.4 |
| Frankenberg at Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster*, 1542 | 7/2.2, p. 277 | 2198 | 10.4.4, 10.7.5 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, pp. 131, 142 | 1576 | 10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.5 |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Christlike kerken-ordeninge*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 49–53, 81 | 1972 | 10.4.3, 10.5.1, 10.7.5 |
| Stift Osnabrück, *Ordinatio Magistri Hermanni Bonni* (Quakenbrück), 1543 | 7/1, p. 229 | 2097 | 10.4.2, 10.6.2, 10.7.5 |
| Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 7/1, p. 256 | 2099 | 10.7.5 |
| Hildesheim (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 7/2.1, pp. 849–851 | 2136 | 10.7.5 |
| Cologne and Paderborn, *Buß-, Fasten-, Bet- und Danktagsordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed) | 22, p. 45 | 1484 | 10.11.3 |
| Stolberg-Königstein, order of the services, 1552 | 9, p. 468 | 2320 | 10.11.2 |
| Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum ducatus Luneburgensis*, 1555 | 6/1, pp. 611–612 | 2009 | 10.4.4 |
| Lüneburg, *Emendatio Breviarii virginum ordinis Sancti Benedicti*, 1555 | 6/1, p. 624 | 2011 | 10.4.4 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 553 | 1963 | 10.7.5 |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9, p. 277 | 2300 | 10.11.3 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 (and Sehling's introduction) | 10, pp. 31, 133–134 | 166, 181 | 10.8.2, 10.9.3 |
| Emden, Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition, 1565 (Reformed) | 7/1, p. 606 | 2116 | 10.10.2, 10.10.6, 10.10.7 |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 251–253 | 2257 | 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 395–397 | 1462 | 10.6.4, 10.8.2, 10.10.2, 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 1085, 1095, 1111, 1113 | 2149, 2150, 2151 | 10.6.4, 10.9.2, 10.9.4, 10.10.2, 10.10.3 |
| Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke Wilhelm the Younger, 1574 | 6/1, pp. 620–621 | 2010 | 10.7.1, 10.8.3 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575 | 6/1, p. 658 | 2017 | 10.9.2 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist) | 10, p. 148 | 182 | 10.10.2 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1150 | 2065 | 10.7.4, 10.9.4 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Leeden (Tecklenburg), *Ordnung für das Zisterzienserinnenkloster*, 1585 | 22, p. 247 | 1506 | 10.6.3 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 | 10, p. 627 | 228 | 10.10.3, 10.10.7 |
| Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 | 9, p. 357 | 2311 | 10.10.4, 10.10.7 |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, p. 153 | 2089 | 10.4.2, 10.9.1 |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 (Sehling's introduction) | 7/1, p. 67 | 2080 | 10.9.2 |
| Lütetsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 (Sehling's note) (Reformed) | 7/1, p. 541 | 2115 | 10.11.2 |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, *Ordnung der Katechisation*, 1609 (Reformed) | 10, pp. 487, 491 | 211 | 10.10.6, 10.10.7 |

**Transylvania**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547 | 24, p. 223 | 1669 | 10.7.5 |

# Chapter 11. Sermons and Preaching

This chapter collects what the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts* say about the **sermon**. It asks:

- What did the reformers and the orders think the sermon was **for**, and what was it to contain?
- **On what occasions** was there preaching: Sundays and feasts, weekdays, the catechism, Lent and the Passion, prayer days, funerals and weddings?
- **What texts** were preached: the old Sunday gospels and epistles, books in course, the catechism, the heads of doctrine?
- **How** was a sermon to be made, and in what manner of speech?
- **How long** was it to last?
- What did the orders say about **postils**, written sermons and preparation?
- What were the limits on **rebuke and controversy** in the pulpit?
- What was done in the pulpit **before and after** the sermon?
- How were **preachers** tested and corrected?
- What was required of the **hearers**?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §11.1 summarizes the findings, and §11.2 sets out the method and cautions.
- §11.3 gives Luther's rulings of 1523 and 1526 and the Saxon visitation of 1528.
- §11.4 covers the occasions and times of preaching, and §11.5 the texts.
- §11.6 covers how to preach, and §11.7 the length of sermons.
- §11.8 deals with postils and preparation, and §11.9 with rebuke and polemic.
- §11.10 covers the pulpit acts around the sermon.
- §11.11 covers preachers, and §11.12 hearers.
- §11.13 is a table by order, and §11.14 a concordance.

## 11.1 Summary of findings

**1. The sermon is the reason for the assembly** (§11.3).

- Luther's first rule, in 1523: the congregation "shall never come together" unless God's Word is preached and prayer made. Where the Word is not preached, "it is better that one neither sing nor read nor come together".
- The visitors of 1528 required **repentance** to be preached with forgiveness. Preaching forgiveness alone makes people "secure and fearless". Later orders speak of preaching "repentance, law and gospel".

**2. The occasions** (§11.4).

- **Sunday and holy days.** The gospel was preached in the morning at the Mass, and the catechism (or the epistle) in the afternoon. Luther's Wittenberg had three Sunday sermons: an early one on the epistle for the servants, the gospel at the Mass, and the Old Testament at Vespers.
- **Weekdays.** One or two weekday sermons, usually Wednesday and Friday (1528). Great towns had more. Early sermons were held for servants and craftsmen before work. Village weekday sermons were often suspended at harvest, or held only in winter.
- **The catechism.** The catechism sermon came on Sunday afternoon, and was also preached through in series several times a year (Torgau: every quarter; Reutlingen: four times a year).
- **Lent and the Passion.** Luther refused "eight hours" of Passion preaching on Good Friday: an hour a day in Holy Week. The later orders divide the Passion harmony into a fixed series of sermons (six in Lent at Henneberg; three on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday at Coburg).
- **Prayer days** (*Bettage*), weekly or monthly, with a sermon of repentance.
- **Funeral sermons** spread from the 1550s. They were to be short, without praise of the dead, and often limited to half an hour. Some towns abolished them.
- **Wedding sermons**: allowed if "short, chaste, Christian", or abolished.

**3. The texts** (§11.5).

- The Lutheran orders **kept the Sunday gospels and epistles**. Luther's reason was that few preachers could handle a whole book "mightily and profitably".
- **Books in course** were preached at Vespers and on weekdays.
- Some orders also asked for the *loci communes* to be covered through the year. The Reformed Palatinate allowed a book in course on Sunday too.

**4. How to preach** (§11.6). The orders describe one shape:

- prayer;
- the text;
- a short summary;
- one to three doctrines;
- their application to the hearers;
- a brief repetition;
- the general prayer.

The sermon is to teach, reprove and comfort: to terrify the secure and comfort the troubled. It is to be in plain words, "so that he may be understood", fitted to the hearers, "in good German".

**5. Length** (§11.7).

- **The chief Sunday sermon: one hour at most**, often three quarters.
- **Weekday, afternoon, catechism, funeral and wedding sermons: half an hour.**
- The reason given is the hearer. "The common people can in no wise remain attentive longer" (Augsburg 1537, Moderate Reformed). The common man is like "a sick man, to whom one must set things often, but little at once" (Württemberg 1536). "Long sermons … weaken the memory and make the hearers weary" (Regensburg 1572).
- Sermons were to be shorter in winter cold (Castell 1579). Overrunning to an hour and a half drew complaints (Hohenlohe 1594).

**6. Postils** (§11.8). There are two phases.

- **Early.** Luther thought it best to read his postil from the pulpit, for weak preachers and against the sects. Saxony in 1545 told poor village pastors to read Corvinus or Luther's *Hauspostille* "until" they could preach themselves.
- **Later.** The complaint reverses: young preachers "adorn themselves with strange feathers" (Saxony 1580). Pastors are to write their own sermons (Nassau-Dillenburg 1570), to use "pure postils" without leaning on them (Wolfstein 1574), and not to go up into the pulpit "without foregoing meditation" (Sponheim 1608).

**7. Rebuke and controversy** (§11.9).

- Preachers were to rebuke vices "in general", and **name no one**. Names were read from the pulpit only for excommunication by sentence of the consistory, and in the banns.
- No private grudges in the pulpit.
- The doctrinal quarrels brought mandates against "railing and condemning": "disputations belong in the universities, and not in the churches in the pulpit" (Ansbach 1570).

**8. Around the sermon** (§11.10). The orders kept the medieval group of vernacular pulpit pieces around the sermon:

- **before**: an exhortation and prayer, often the Our Father or "Nun bitten wir"; in the Palatinate (Reformed) the apostolic greeting;
- **after**: the open confession and absolution, the general prayer with particular intercessions, and the notices and banns.

**9. Preachers** (§11.11).

- Candidates passed an examination and a **trial sermon**.
- Pastors already in office preached practice sermons on set texts before the superintendent (Saxony 1577).
- In the Palatine class conventions (1587, Reformed) a colleague's sermon was **censured point by point**: division of the text, scope, digressions, pace, "good German".

**10. Hearers** (§11.12).

- Attendance was a duty, enforced by counting and fines (one person per house at weekday sermons, Ysenburg 1588).
- Taverns were shut and trade, games and labour service forbidden during the sermon.
- Chattering, sleeping, coming late and leaving early were fined (Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1591, Reformed).
- The people were to be exhorted to stay to the end of the service.

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## 11.2 Scope, sources and cautions

**What was searched.** The `eko.db` database was searched for the sermon by its names, in High and Low German and Latin spellings:

- *predig*, *predigt*, *predigen*, *sermon*, *concio*;
- *Frühpredigt*, *Mittagspredigt*, *Vesperpredigt*, *Wochenpredigt*, *Katechismuspredigt*, *Passionspredigt*, *Bettag*, *Leichpredigt*, *Hochzeitpredigt*, *Brautpredigt*, *Probpredigt*.

It was also searched for:

- length (*stund*, *halbe stund*, *drei viertel*);
- books and preparation (*postill*, *concipiren*, *meditation*);
- rebuke and controversy (*canzel* with *schelten*, *schmehen*, *lestern*, *mit namen*, *privat affect*, *disputation*);
- the pulpit acts (*vater unser* before the sermon, *Ave Maria*, *Gnad, fried*, *abkündigung*, *gemein gebet*);
- the hearers (*unter der predigt* with *schenken*, *zechen*, *kaufen*, *spazieren*, *schwätzen*, *schlafen*, and fines).

The passages were then read in context, and their orders identified from Sehling's running heads.

**Related chapters.**

- Chapter 8 covers the hymns before the sermon ("Nun bitten wir", §8.10) and after it ("Erhalt uns, Herr", §8.11).
- Chapter 4 covers the epistle and gospel lessons on which the Sunday sermon was preached (§4.5).
- Chapter 6 covers the general prayer said from the pulpit after the sermon.
- Chapter 10 covers the daily lessons with exposition (§10.3.1) and the sermon inside Vespers (§10.7.4).
- Chapter 12 covers the half-holidays kept "with a sermon", Lent and the other seasons, and the days of fasting and prayer.
- Chapter 16 covers the deacons and chaplains who preached the lesser sermons.
- Chapter 17 covers the oaths by which preachers bound their doctrine to Scripture and the confessions.
- Chapter 15 covers the pastor's study and books, the training of preachers, and the hearers' duties (§§15.3.2, 15.7, 15.8.1).
- Chapter 13 covers the wedding and funeral rites in which those sermons stood, and the council-election sermon (§§13.7, 13.9, 13.13.1).
- Chapter 9 covers the sermon glass (§9.5.9).
- Chapter 3 covers prayers before and after the sermon in the communion service (§3.6.4).

**Cautions.** Five things limit what the corpus can show:

- **Church orders are not sermons.** Sehling prints rules, visitation articles and reports, not sermons or homiletic handbooks. The orders say what was required and what went wrong. How sermons actually sounded must be learned from the printed sermons and postils, which lie outside the corpus.
- **Silence is not absence.** Many orders say only "the sermon follows". Lengths, days and methods are stated where someone thought them in doubt. A missing rule does not mean that there was no custom.
- **Complaints are evidence of the rule.** The many complaints (sermons of an hour and a half, borrowed postils, railing from the pulpit, empty weekday sermons, taverns open during the sermon) show the abuses the rules were made against. They do not show how common the abuses were.
- **Orders of other traditions.** Sehling prints Reformed orders for the Palatinate, Hesse-Kassel, Nassau, Ysenburg, Hanau, Anhalt, East Frisia and the Lower Rhine, the Moderate Reformed orders of the Upper German cities and Philip's Hesse, and the Philippist orders of Bremen and of Hesse under Philip's sons. They are cited here where they bear on the same questions (the Palatine class conventions, the greeting, books in course, the length of the sermon), and each is marked with its tradition. The wider Reformed practice of Sunday preaching in course is noted but not pursued.
- **Dates.** Several texts survive in later copies, or are pastors' reports undated except by the visitation. Their dates are given as Sehling gives them.

## 11.3 Luther and the visitors: the sermon first

### 11.3.1 1523: no gathering without the Word

**The first rule.** Luther's first sketch of a reformed service names three abuses: the Word was silenced, fables filled the silence, and the service was done as a work. From this he draws the rule on which every later order rests. The congregation is never to meet unless God's Word is preached and prayer is made, "though it be most briefly". **Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 2):

> Drei grosse missbreuch sind in den gottis dienst gefallen. Der erst, das man gottis wort geschwigen hat, und alleine gelesen und gesungen in den kirchen, das ist der ergiste missbrauch. [...] Nu dise missbreuch abzuthun, ist aufs erst zu wissen, das die christlich gemeine nimer soll zu samen komen, es werde denn da selbs gottis wort gepredigt und gebett, es sei auch aufs kurzist. [...] Darumb wo nicht gotts wort predigt wirt, ists besser, das man wider singe noch lese, noch zu samen kome.

Three great abuses are fallen into the service of God. The first, that God's word hath been kept silent, and [men have] only read and sung in the churches; that is the worst abuse. [...] Now to put away these abuses, it is first to be known that the Christian congregation shall never come together, except God's word be there preached and prayer made, be it also most briefly. [...] Therefore where God's word is not preached, it is better that one neither sing nor read nor come together.

The same treatise makes the daily morning and evening gatherings into a lesson with its exposition (see Chapter 10 §10.3.1). Preaching is the reason for the assembly, not an ornament of it.

### 11.3.2 1526: three sermons on a Sunday

**The Wittenberg Sunday.** In the *Deutsche Messe* Luther sets out the Sunday he had in Wittenberg. There are three sermons:

- at five or six, after psalms "as at Matins", on the **epistle**, for the household servants who cannot come later;
- at the Mass, at eight or nine, on the **gospel**;
- at Vespers in the afternoon, on the **Old Testament** "in order, one after another".

**Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 13):

> Des heiligen tags oder sontags lassen wir bleiben die gewonlichen epistel und evangelia und haben drei predigt. Frue umb funfe oder sechse singet man etliche psalmen als zur metten. Darnach predigt man die epistel des tages, aller meist umb des gesindes willen, das die auch versorget werden und gottis wort hören, ob sie ja in andern predigeten nicht sein kunden. [...] Unter der messe umb acht oder neune predigt man das evangelion, das die zeit gibt durchs jar. Nach mittage unter der vesper fur dem Magnificat predigt man das alte testament ordentlich nacheinander.

On the holy day or Sunday we let remain the customary epistles and gospels, and have three sermons. Early, at five or six, certain psalms are sung, as at Matins. Thereafter the epistle of the day is preached, most of all for the household servants' sake, that they also may be provided for and hear God's word, if haply they could not be at the other sermons. [...] At the Mass, at eight or nine, the gospel is preached which the season giveth through the year. In the afternoon, at Vespers, before the *Magnificat*, the Old Testament is preached in order, one after another.

The same pattern of morning, Mass and Vespers sermons runs through the town orders for the rest of the century (§11.4.1). The Vespers sermon of the north German towns is described in Chapter 10 §10.7.4.

### 11.3.3 The visitors of 1528: repentance and faith, Wednesday and Friday

**What to preach.** The *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528 begins its doctrine with a complaint. Many preach only the forgiveness of sins and leave out repentance, and the people grow "secure and fearless". **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 152):

> Denn Christus spricht, Luce am letzten cap., das man predigen sol in seinem namen, busse und vergebung der sünden. Aber viel itzund sagen allein von vergebung der sünde, und sagen nichts, oder wenig, von busse. So doch on busse kein vergebung der sunden ist. Es kan auch vergebung der sünden nicht verstanden werden on busse. Und so man die

> vergebung der sunden prediget on busse, folget, das die leute wenen, sie haben schon vergebung der sunden erlanget, und werden dadurch sicher und forchtlos.

For Christ saith, in the last chapter of Luke, that repentance and forgiveness of sins should be preached in his name. But many now speak only of the forgiveness of sins, and say nothing, or little, of repentance. Whereas without repentance there is no forgiveness of sins. Neither can forgiveness of sins be understood without repentance. And when forgiveness of sins is preached without repentance, it followeth that the people ween they have already obtained forgiveness of sins, and become thereby secure and fearless.

**When to preach.** The same book fixes the week. Besides the Sunday morning and Vespers sermons, there is to be preaching on **Wednesday and Friday**, from "useful and not hard books". **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 168):

> In der wochen sol man predigen am mitwoch und freitag. Es sol auch ein pfarherr vleis ankeren, das man nützliche und nicht schwere bücher fürneme zu predigen. Das auch der glaube also geprediget werde, das man der rechtschaffen christlichen busse, gottes gericht, gottesforcht, und guter werk […] nicht vergesse, denn man on die busse glauben nicht haben oder verstehen mag. Am feiertag, soll man morgens und zur vesper predigen, morgens das evangelion, nachmittag, weil das gesinde und junge volk in die kirchen kömpt, halten wir für gut, das man sontags nach mittag stetigs für und für, die zehen gebot, die artikel des glaubens, und das vater unser predige und auslege.

In the week one shall preach on Wednesday and Friday. A pastor shall also apply diligence that useful and not hard books be taken in hand to preach. [And] that faith also be so preached, that true Christian repentance, God's judgement, the fear of God and good works […] be not forgotten; for without repentance one cannot have or understand faith. On the holy day one shall preach in the morning and at Vespers: in the morning the gospel; in the afternoon, because the servants and the young folk come into the church, we hold it good that on Sunday afternoon one continually, over and over, preach and expound the Ten Commandments, the articles of the faith and the Our Father.

These two passages set the pattern for the century: gospel on Sunday morning, catechism in the afternoon, and one or two weekday sermons, with repentance preached together with faith.

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## 11.4 Occasions and times

### 11.4.1 Sundays and feasts: the gospel in the morning, the catechism after noon

**The standard Sunday.** By mid-century the standard parish Sunday has two sermons:

- in the morning, on the **gospel** of the day, with the Lord's Supper when there are communicants;
- in the afternoon, on the **catechism** (in towns often the epistle instead, or both).

Where the young people cannot come on weekdays because of the field work, the catechism is kept for Sunday and the epistle moves to a weekday. **Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 323):

> sollen sie ire predigten also ordenen und disponiren, das allewege auf die sontage und andere christliche fest das evangelium frue geprediget, und, do communicanten vorhanden, das ambt gehalten, nachmittag aber allezeit der catechismus geprediget und geübet, und sonsten in der wochen auch eines tages einmal geprediget werde. Da auch das junge volk in der wochen von wegen des ackerbauens, oder anderer arbeit verhindert nicht leichtlich könt in die kirchen kommen, sol der catechismus auf den sontag nach mittage, und die epistel auf einen andern tag in der wochen ausgelegt werden

they shall so order and dispose their sermons, that always on the Sundays and other Christian feasts the gospel be preached early, and, where communicants be present, the office [of the Mass] be held, but in the afternoon the catechism be at all times preached and exercised, and otherwise in the week also on one day [there] be preaching once. And whereas the young folk in the week, by reason of the tilling of the fields or other work, could not easily come into the church, the catechism shall be expounded on Sunday afternoon, and the epistle on another day in the week

The great towns had more. Wittenberg in 1533 had preaching on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday mornings (Sehling 1, p. 701).

### 11.4.2 Weekday sermons

**One or two a week.** The weekday sermon (*Wochenpredigt*) is required almost everywhere. Its usual days are Wednesday and Friday, or one of them. In the villages it is often suspended when the fields need the people. **Schlieben, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 659):

> Am donnerstage in der wochen wirt eine predigt gethan, ausgenommen mitten im sommer von wegen des volks notiger arbeit und mitten im winter von wegen des volks, da wirt sie unterlassen. Anfenglich singet man einen deutschen gesang, dabei sich das volk samle. 2. Folget die predigt, darin entweder der catechismus gehandelt wird, auf das er in einem jahre hinaus gepredigt werden kan, oder so aposteltage fürfallen, die man nicht feierlich helt, wird dasselbige evangelium an solchem tage in der wochen gepredigt, oder epistola dominicalis. In der fasten wirt historia passionis dazu gebraucht.

On Thursday in the week a sermon is made, except in midsummer by reason of the people's needful work, and in midwinter by reason of the people; then it is left off. At the beginning a German hymn is sung, whereby the people may gather. 2. The sermon followeth, wherein either the catechism is handled, that it may be preached through in one year, or, if apostles' days fall which are not kept solemnly, the same gospel is preached on such a day in the week, or the Sunday epistle. In Lent the history of the Passion is used for it.

Reutlingen turns the rule round. The village pastors are to preach a weekday sermon in **winter**, "when there is no special business in the field". **Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531** (Sehling 17/2, p. 42):

> Sollichs soll auch den pfarhern in dörffern auffgelegt werden, also das sy auch den catechismum zu vier malen im jar predigen auff die feirtag nach dem morgenessen, darzu, das sy zu wintters zit, wann man nit sonder geschefft am feldt hat, alle wochen, so kein feyrtag darynn ist, am wercktag nach gelegenheit eins yden fleckenn auch ain predig thuen.

This shall also be laid upon the pastors in the villages, that they also preach the catechism four times in the year, on the holy days after the morning meal; moreover, that in winter time, when there is no special business in the field, every week wherein is no holy day, they also do a sermon on a working day, according to the occasion of each place.

**The early sermon for working people.** In the towns an early weekday sermon (*Frühpredigt*) was held before the day's work, for servants, day labourers and craftsmen, and kept to half an hour. **Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 726):

> Die zwene caplan in unser frauen pfarkirchen sollen drei tage in der wochen die fruepredigt vor das gesinde, tagelöner und handwergsleut halten, als nemlich dinstag, freitag und sonabend, weil die andern drei tage ane das geprediget wird. Desgleichen sollen auch die zwene zu S. Katharinen in irer pfarkirchen thun, und in peden kirchen nit lenger dan ein halb stunde die predigt vorziehen.

The two chaplains in Our Lady's parish church shall hold the early sermon three days in the week for the servants, day labourers and craftsmen, namely Tuesday, Friday and Saturday, because on the other three days there is preaching anyhow. Likewise shall the two at St Katharine's also do in their parish church, and in both churches not draw out the sermon longer than half an hour.

Late in the century the weekday sermon was often badly attended. The counts of Ysenburg and others required at least one person from each house to be present (§11.12.1).

### 11.4.3 Catechism sermons

**Every Sunday afternoon, and in series.** The catechism sermon (*Katechismuspredigt*) is normally the Sunday afternoon sermon (§11.4.1). Many orders add a series in which the whole catechism is preached through in a few weeks. Reutlingen has it "four times in the year" (§11.4.2). At Torgau the four deacons preached the Small Catechism every quarter, for a fortnight on end. **Torgau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren von 1575*** (Sehling 1, p. 683):

> Der pfarher im spital herr Joachim Sella legt des sontags zur früepredigt das evangelium dominicale aus, des donnerstags durch das ganze jar erkleret er den catechismum Lutheri. Der kleine catechismus würde alle quartal, vierzehen tage nacheinander in der wochen von den vier diaconis ordentlichen geprediget und erkleret.

The pastor in the hospital, Herr Joachim Sella, expoundeth the Sunday gospel at the early sermon on Sunday; on Thursday, through the whole year, he explaineth Luther's catechism. The Small Catechism is every quarter, fourteen days one after another in the week, preached and explained in order by the four deacons.

The catechism sermon was often followed by an examination of the children (*Kinderlehre*, *examen*). Its length was usually set at half an hour (§11.7.2).

### 11.4.4 Lent and the Passion

**Luther: not eight hours on Good Friday.** The *Deutsche Messe* keeps Lent and the Passion gospels, but not the old Holy Week. Holy Week shall be "like other weeks", save that the Passion is preached an hour a day. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

> doch nicht also, das man das hunger tuch, palmen schiessen, bilde decken und was des gauckel werks mehr ist, halten oder vier passion singen oder acht stunden am karfreitag an der passion zu predigen haben, sonder die marterwoche sol gleich wie ander wochen sein, on das man die passion predige des tages eine stunde durch die woche oder wie viel tage es gelustet, und das sacrament neme wer do wil.

yet not so that one keep the Lenten veil, the shooting of palms, the covering of images, and whatever more there is of that juggling work, or sing four Passions, or have to preach eight hours on the Passion on Good Friday; but Holy Week shall be even as other weeks, save that the Passion be preached an hour a day through the week, or on as many days as one listeth, and that whosoever will receive the sacrament.

**The Passion harmony in series.** The later orders divide the Passion history into a fixed number of sermons. Henneberg 1582 has six in Lent, the first on Quinquagesima as a summary of what is to come (Sehling 2, p. 313). The Coburg synod of 1580 advises that the whole history be laid out on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday "in three distinct sermons". **Coburg, *Beschlüsse des coburgischen Synodus*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 255):

> doch wird es vor nützlichen gehalten, das in dörfern und stedten die ganze historia passionis uf den donnerstag und karfreitag, wie sie sich begeben, in dreien unterschiedlichen predigten, dem volk kürzlich und einfeltig ausgeleget, damit die ganze historia, wie auch den andern festen der geburt und himmelfart Christi gebreuchlich, der gestalt das gemeine volk unverstendig dieselbige besser fassen, lernen und behalten mögte.

yet it is held profitable that in villages and towns the whole history of the Passion, on the Thursday and Good Friday, as it came to pass, be expounded to the people briefly and simply in three distinct sermons, that the whole history (as is customary also at the other feasts of the Nativity and Ascension of Christ) the unlearned common people might in such wise the better grasp, learn and retain [it].

### 11.4.5 Prayer days

**Days of repentance.** From the 1540s, and above all in time of war, plague and the Turkish threat, the orders appoint **prayer days** (*Bettage*). These were weekly, monthly or occasional, with a sermon of repentance at their centre. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 260):

> Derhalben werden bei uns uf gewisse bestimpte tage bettage angestelt und gehalten, in welchen durch die predig die leut in erkantnus ihrer sünde bracht, zur buß und glauben vermanet, zum ernsten gebet und zu abbittung der straffe, auch zur besserung ihres lebens treulich angehalten werden.

Therefore with us prayer days are appointed and held on certain fixed days, in which by the sermon the people are brought into knowledge of their sins, exhorted to repentance and faith, and faithfully held to earnest prayer and to the begging off of the punishment, and also to the amendment of their life.

The Palatine orders of the 1590s (Reformed) required attendance at the monthly prayer day on pain of a fine (Sehling 19/2, pp. 777, 780).

The calendar of prayer days is treated in Chapter 12, §12.13.5, and the Litany sung on them in Chapter 13, §13.22.4.

### 11.4.6 Funeral sermons

**Not a eulogy.** The funeral sermon (*Leichpredigt*) spread from the 1550s. At Gardelegen in the Mark, the first funeral sermon was held in 1554 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 3, p. 218). Most orders allow it when the family asks for it. Many keep it short and forbid praise of the dead. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 406):

> Darauf soll er eine kurtze predig oder vermanung thun und sich ubriges lobens der abgestorbenen enthalten, damit die leichpredigen nit in mißbrauch gerahten.

Thereupon shall he do a short sermon or exhortation, and refrain from excessive praise of the departed, that the funeral sermons fall not into abuse.

**What to preach, and from what book.** At the grave the subject is mortality, sin and death, redemption, the resurrection and eternal life. The Oldenburg order points the pastor to the printed funeral sermons of Johann Spangenberg and Johannes Mathesius. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1109):

> sol der kirchendiener auftretten und von sterbhcheit und schwacheit der menschen, von ursachen der sünden und des tods, von erlösung durch Christum geschehen, von auferstehung der todten, von ewigen leben und dergleichen ein kurzen sermon und vermanung tun, wie er denn dazu aus den leichpredigten, so von alten herrn Johanne Spangenbergio, herrn Matthesio und andern […]

the minister shall step forth and of the mortality and weakness of men, of the causes of sin and of death, of the redemption made through Christ, of the resurrection of the dead, of eternal life and the like, do a short sermon and exhortation, as he [may] for this [draw] from the funeral sermons which by old Master Johann Spangenberg, Master Mathesius and others […]

**Half an hour, or none at all.** Mecklenburg limits it: "if a funeral sermon is held, it shall not be over half an hour" (*Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560; Sehling 5, p. 290). The Hohenlohe visitors set the same limit (Sehling 15, p. 427). Some towns abolished funeral sermons altogether, putting the old exhortation and a collect in their place, so that the people would not be kept too long. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda* (agreed by the council with the ministers), 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 481):

> Zum dritten, sollen die leichpredigten aus allerhand ursachen durchaus abgeschafft sein und an stat deroselben die alte verordente vermahnung, so ein generale funus, durch den hern pfarhern bei der hauswirt oder alten leichen, und die collecta, so man vor den heusern pflegt zulesen, bei der kinder und jungen leute begräbnus gelesen und die benedictio daruf gesprochen werden, damit die leute zulange nicht aufgehalten und die jugend in der schuelen verseumet werde

Thirdly, the funeral sermons shall for all manner of reasons be wholly abolished, and in their stead the old appointed exhortation, [at] a general funeral, [be read] by the pastor at [the burial of] householders or old people, and the collect which is wont to be read before the houses be read at the burial of children and young people, and the blessing spoken thereupon, that the people be not kept too long, and the youth in the school be not neglected.

Several orders refuse a funeral sermon for small children who had not yet come to the Lord's Supper (Sehling 22, p. 480; Sehling 19/1, p. 430).

The burial rites in which the funeral sermon stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.9.

### 11.4.7 Wedding sermons

**Short and chaste.** The wedding sermon (*Hochzeitpredigt*, *Brautpredigt*) was customary in many places and abolished in others. Anhalt allows it where custom has it or it is asked for, but it must be "short, chaste and Christian". **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 582):

> eine kurze, züchtige, christliche hochzeitpredigt (hindangesetzt alle ungeistliche, possirliche phrases und unzimliche sprichwörter, dadurch züchtige ohren der jugend leichtlich können verletzet werden) zur besserung gehalten, dazu denn die leut nüchtern und attent kommen sollen.

a short, chaste, Christian wedding sermon (all unspiritual, droll phrases and unseemly proverbs set aside, whereby the chaste ears of the youth may lightly be hurt) [be] held for edification, to which the people shall come sober and attentive.

Aschersleben abolished it in the same article as the funeral sermon. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 481):

> Es sollen forthin alle hochzeitpredigten abgeschafft sein, braut und breutgamb mit ihren geladenen gästen nur einmal des montags und nicht auch des sontags, wie bishero geschehen, in die kirchen zur trauung gehen, und also des montags die copulation und segen zugleich ohne alle predigt geschehen.

Henceforth all wedding sermons shall be abolished; bride and bridegroom with their bidden guests [shall] go into the church to the marriage only once, on the Monday, and not also on the Sunday, as hath been done hitherto; and so on the Monday the joining and the blessing [shall] be done together, without any sermon.

At Grubenhagen, wedding guests were forbidden to lie "at the drinking, the early soup or the brandy" during the wedding sermon (Sehling 6/2, p. 1065).

The marriage rites in which the wedding sermon stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.7.

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## 11.5 Texts: what was preached on

### 11.5.1 The Sunday gospels and epistles kept

**Why Luther kept the pericopes.** Luther kept the old series of Sunday epistles and gospels (§11.3.2). He gave a practical reason: few preachers can handle a whole evangelist or another book "mightily and profitably". **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 15):

> Denn auch das der ursachen eine ist, das wir die episteln und evangelia, wie sie in den postillen geordenet stehen, behalten, . das der geistreichen prediger wenig sind, die einen ganzen evangelisten oder ander buch gewaltiglich und nutzlich handeln mugen.

For this also is one of the causes why we keep the epistles and gospels as they stand ordered in the postils: that there are few spiritual preachers who can handle a whole evangelist or other book mightily and profitably.

The Lutheran orders follow him almost without exception. The visitation articles ask whether the pastor preaches "the Sunday gospels" (*dominicalia evangelia*). The Hohenlohe visitors of 1578 charged a pastor with not keeping to the appointed gospels (Sehling's note, Sehling 15, p. 248). The lessons themselves are treated in Chapter 4 §4.5.

### 11.5.2 Books in course on weekdays and at Vespers

**Lectio continua beside the pericopes.** Continuous preaching through a book of the Bible (*lectio continua*) was not given up. It was moved to Vespers and to the weekday sermons. Luther preached the Old Testament "in order" at Sunday Vespers (§11.3.2). The visitors of 1528 wanted "useful and not hard books" for the weekday sermons (§11.3.3). In the towns the weekday preachers worked through whole books. **Rötha, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha*, 1574** (Sehling 1, p. 653):

> In der wochen wird am mittwoch früe gepredigt und gehandelt die bücher der heilichen schrift wie sie nach einander gehen, die vornembsten historien ein capitel nach dem andern, in der fasten den sontage zu mittage und an mittwoch wird die passion gepredigt.

In the week, on Wednesday early, there is preaching, and the books of holy Scripture are handled as they go one after another, the chief histories, one chapter after another; in Lent, on Sunday at midday and on Wednesday, the Passion is preached.

The Reformed Palatine order of 1563, repeated in 1601, goes further. Sermons are to be taken from the canonical books, and those books expounded which are "most profitable to the common man and most edifying to the church". In 1563 this applied "chiefly on the Sundays" (Sehling 14, p. 557, with the variant noted there). The order thus allows a book in course on Sunday as well as on weekdays.

### 11.5.3 The chief articles of doctrine through the year

**Loci communes.** Some orders asked the preacher to cover the chief heads of doctrine (*loci communes*) in the course of a year's Sunday sermons. Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 has this rule (quoted in §11.10.4). The catechism sermon did the same in a smaller compass. Where a sermon was on a feast, the doctrine of the feast was to be taught: the Supper on Maundy Thursday (Mecklenburg c. 1560, Sehling 5, p. 290), and the Passion on Good Friday (§11.4.4).

## 11.6 How to preach

### 11.6.1 The shape of a sermon

**Prayer, text, summary, doctrines, application, repetition.** The orders rarely give a homiletic. Where they describe a sermon, they describe the same shape:

1. an exhortation to prayer, and a prayer or hymn;
2. the reading of the text;
3. a short summary (*summa*) of the text;
4. one, two or three doctrines drawn from it;
5. their application to the hearers;
6. a short repetition at the end;
7. the general prayer.

A village pastor in the county of Henneberg described his own practice in his report to the visitors. **Ritschenhausen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 345):

> idoch halte ich in meinen predigten gemeiniglich diesen proces und ordnung. 1. Vermane ich das volk zum gebet, darnach vertir ich aus einem buch den text des ordentlichen evangelii oder historien und zeige kurzlich den inhalt, desgleichen, wo es in die stück christlicher lehr gehorig, an; nehme nochmals heraus 1, 2 oder 3 lehr nach gelegenheit der zeit und zuhorer, darauf ich die dieselbe applicire. Entlichen widerhole ich kürzlich was gehandelt und beschlis also die predigt mit dem gemeinem gebet für alle stend und anligende not der ganzen christenheit und weret die ganze predigt uber 3 virtel einer stund nicht.

yet I keep in my sermons commonly this process and order. 1. I exhort the people to prayer; thereafter I [read] out of a book the text of the appointed gospel or history, and show briefly the content, likewise where it belongeth among the parts of Christian doctrine; then I take out of it 1, 2 or 3 doctrines, according to the occasion of the time and the hearers, whereupon I apply the same. Finally I repeat briefly what hath been handled, and so close the sermon with the general prayer for all estates and the present need of the whole of Christendom; and the whole sermon lasteth not over three quarters of an hour.

A Saxon town order describes the same outline, with the propositions repeated at the end "that the hearers may know what they shall carry home with them". **Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung zur Gotleuben*, 1567–1577** (Sehling 1, p. 567):

> Darauf folget die predigt, welche gemeiniglich über eine stunde sich nicht vorzeucht vom evangelio, da erstlich summa angezeicht, darnach propositiones oder themata, davon man handlen will, welche in fine repetirt, damit die auditores wissen, was sie mit sich anheim tragen sollen. Gemeingebet. Nach allen predigten bittet man für die not der ganze werde christenheit, vor alle drei regiment, geistlich, weltlich, und haushaltung, und auch für sondrer personen, die das gemeine gebet begeren und bedurfen.

Thereupon followeth the sermon on the gospel, which commonly is not drawn out over an hour; wherein first the sum is shown, thereafter the propositions or themes which one will handle, which are repeated at the end, that the hearers may know what they shall carry home with them. The general prayer. After all sermons prayer is made for the need of the whole worthy Christendom, for all three governments, spiritual, temporal and the household, and also for particular persons who desire and need the common prayer.

**Doctrine, terror, comfort, exhortation.** The Corvey order of 1603, for the village of Bruchhausen, sets out the same shape. It adds what the sermon is to do to each kind of hearer: the ungodly are to be terrified, the troubled comforted, the careless warned. **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 244):

> Folgents wirt die Predig angefangen, da dann, nach dem der Pfarher vom Predigstul ein kurtze vermahnung zum gebett gethan, die gantze Kirche eindrechtiglich singet das Vatter unser oder einen andern gewönlichen gesang nach gelegenheit der zeit. Nach diesem gesange wirdt der Text verlesen und folget darauff ein Christlich, dem Glauben ehnlich, auß Gottes Wort gezogen und mit demselben confirmirte und bestetigte erklerung, darin denn alle wege nach erforderung der fürgelesenen worte eins oder mehr Heuptstücke der Christlichen lehre fein ordentlich und unterscheidlich auffs aller kürtzeste, Also das es die einfeltigen vernehmen, begreiffen und behalten mügen, zur

> unterweisung fürtragen, die rohen, Gottlosen mit verkündigung Göttliches zorns geschrecket, die Gottseligen, ihrer Sünden halber bekümmerte Hertzen mit erinnerung Göttlicher gnaden getröstet, Die sichern und fahrlessigen ermahnet und einem jedern nach gelegenheit etwas zur besserung fürgehalten werden soll.

Next the sermon is begun; wherein, after the pastor hath made from the pulpit a short exhortation to prayer, the whole church with one accord singeth the Our Father, or another customary hymn according to the occasion of the time. After this hymn the text is read, and thereupon followeth a Christian explanation, agreeable to the faith, drawn out of God's Word and confirmed and established therewith; wherein always, as the words read out require, one or more chief parts of Christian doctrine shall be set forth for instruction, finely, orderly and distinctly, as briefly as may be, so that the simple may perceive, grasp and retain it; the rude [and] ungodly shall be terrified with the proclamation of God's wrath; the godly, hearts troubled because of their sins, comforted with the remembrance of God's grace; the secure and careless exhorted; and to every one, as occasion serveth, something set before him for amendment.

### 11.6.2 Law and gospel, repentance and faith

**The content.** The visitors of 1528 insisted that repentance be preached with forgiveness (§11.3.3). The later orders put the same thing in the language of law and gospel. **Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 96):

> Alle pfarrer sollen auch vleissig vor allen dingen der lehre und ires pfar ampts und selsorg warten, und dasselbige durch die predige der buss, des gesetz und evangelii, glauben und liebe, gedult und auch die gute werk von got geboten mit allen treuen vleis treiben, one welchs kein selwartung oder recht christlich gemein bestehen kann.

All pastors shall also diligently, before all things, wait upon the doctrine and their pastoral office and cure of souls, and drive the same with all faithful diligence by the preaching of repentance, of the law and the gospel, faith and love, patience, and also the good works commanded of God; without which no cure of souls nor right Christian congregation can stand.

**The uses of the sermon.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) lists the uses of a sermon from 2 Timothy 3:16. It sets the limit of an hour, and it points to the short but weighty sermons of the Fathers. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 242):

> Es sollen aber die predigten nit uber ein stund weren und dahin gerichtet sein, daß sie leren, straffen, züchtigen, vermanen, bessern, trösten und sterken. Man find oft in der heiligen vetter bücher kurze predige, aber gar wichtig und welche den zuhörern das herz treffen und bewegen und ein merklich nachdenkens hinder sich lassen.

But the sermons shall not last over an hour, and shall be directed thereto, that they teach, reprove, correct, exhort, amend, comfort and strengthen. One findeth oft in the books of the holy Fathers short sermons, but very weighty, and such as smite and move the hearts of the hearers and leave behind them a notable reflection.

### 11.6.3 Plain speech for the common man

**Clear words, no bitterness.** The orders want the sermon plain enough for the simple to follow. Schleswig-Holstein 1542 puts the method, the length and the manner into one paragraph:

- pray first, read the text, then expound it;
- not more than an hour;
- speak the truth "with clean words, so that he may be understood";
- no abuse and no rebuking anyone by name from the pulpit (§11.9.1).

**Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 91):

> De, de Predigen wil, schal thom ersten dat volck vormanen tho vlitiger anropinge der hulpe Gades, Darna den Text, den he duden wil, dem volcke vorlesen, Thom lesten ock uthleggen, nicht aver eine stunde lanck synen Sermon vorthen, ock syner bewechnisse nicht nageven, allene, wat de warheit ys, dat schal he mit reinen wörden uthsprecken, So dat he möge vorstan werden. Yn Sonderheit schal sick ein Prediger aller scheldwort unde bittericheit entholden, ock nemande up dem predigstole mit namen straffen, allene de laster ynt gemene hen, unde wat he vor gewisse gehört hefft, anfechten unde vordömen. Wes eme nicht bewust, darvan mach he swigen.

He that will preach shall first exhort the people to diligent calling upon the help of God; thereafter read to the people the text which he will expound; lastly also lay it out, [and] not draw out his sermon over an hour long, nor give way to his [own] emotion; only what is the truth, that shall he speak out with clean words, so that he may be understood. In especial shall a preacher refrain from all words of railing and bitterness, and rebuke no one from the pulpit by name; only assail and condemn the vices in general, and what he hath heard for certain. Whereof he hath no knowledge, thereof may he be silent.

**Fitted to the hearers.** At the end of the century the Reformed Upper Palatine government told its preachers to suit the sermon to the hearers. They were to repeat the foundations "in the simplest way", and to show the hearers how to apply them in repentance and prayer. **Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Generalanweisung*, 1598** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 349):

> daß sie sich in ihren predigen nach der gelegenheit der zuhörer richten, denselben dasjenige, so zum rechten fundament der christlichen lehr und zu wahrer gottseeligkeit dienstlich, wie sie das sonsten in den predigten oft und viel uf das einfaltigste widerholen und wol inculciren, auch zeigen, wie sie dasselbige in exercitiis poenitentiae et invocationis ihnen selbst appliciren und gottseelich brauchen sollen.

that they direct themselves in their sermons according to the condition of the hearers, [and] that which serveth to the right foundation of Christian doctrine and to true godliness, the same they [shall] otherwise in the sermons oft and much repeat in the simplest way and well inculcate, and also show how they shall apply the same to themselves in the exercises of repentance and of prayer, and use it godly.

The Palatine class conventions of 1587 (Reformed) asked whether a preacher used "good German" and not "Netherlandish phrases", and whether he spoke slowly enough (§11.11.3).

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## 11.7 Length

### 11.7.1 An hour on Sunday morning, at most

**The common rule.** Almost every order that sets a length gives the chief Sunday sermon **one hour at most**. Many give it three quarters. The reason given is always the hearer: the common man cannot attend longer, nor carry more away. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 58):

> Es sollen auch dise alle gemaine sontägspredigen nit uber ain stund weren; dann das gemain volk je nieht lenger ufmerklich bleiben und, was man da handlet zur besserung, behalten kan.

All these common Sunday sermons also shall not last over an hour; for the common people can in no wise remain attentive longer, and retain what is there handled for [their] amendment.

The Württemberg order of 1536 compares the common man to a sick man, "to whom one must set food often, but little at once". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 104):

> Es sollen aber die predigen auch auff die Sontag unnd Feyrtag über ein stundt nit verzogen werden, damit die leut nit mit der vile unnd lengin überschütt und verdrützig werden, dieweil ye des gemeinen mans verstandt sich nit dermass auff einmal sovill mit lust zufassen auffthun mag, sonder mit ihme gleichsam einem krancken zuhandlen, dem man offt, aber wenig auff einmal fürstellen mus.

But the sermons also on Sundays and holy days shall not be drawn out over an hour, that the people be not overwhelmed with the muchness and length, and grow weary; since the understanding of the common man can in no wise open itself to grasp so much at once with delight, but [one must] deal with him as it were with a sick man, to whom one must set [things] before him often, but little at once.

The Hohenlohe order of 1578 repeats this sentence almost word for word, and sets the length at "three quarters of an hour, and at the most not over an hour" (Sehling 15, p. 263).

Regensburg gives a reason from memory: long sermons do not edify; "they weaken the memory and make the hearers weary". **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 13, p. 510):

> Nachdeme lange predigten nicht erbaulich, sondern die gedächtnus schwächen und die zuhörer verdrossen machen, sollen die morgenpredigten an sonn- und feiertägen nicht mehr über eine stund verzogen, sondern aufs längst eine

> stunde gehalten werden. In den wochenpredigten aber sollen die ministri sich nicht weniger, sondern auch vielmehr der kürze befleißigen

Forasmuch as long sermons are not edifying, but weaken the memory and make the hearers weary, the morning sermons on Sundays and holy days shall not be drawn out more than over an hour, but be held an hour at the longest. In the weekday sermons, however, the ministers shall study brevity no less, but rather much more

#### 11.7.2 Half an hour on weekdays and for the catechism

**Shorter sermons.** The afternoon, weekday, catechism, funeral and wedding sermons are generally held to **half an hour**. The Saxon visitors of 1580 were told to ask about all three limits. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 393):

> Ob er auch lenger denn ein stund, morgens an sonn und feiertagen predige. Ob er die mittagspredigt also anstelle, das mit singen und allem lenger nicht denn ein stund das volk aufgehalten werde. Ob er am werktage uber ein halbe stund predige.

Whether he preach longer than an hour in the morning on Sundays and holy days. Whether he so order the midday sermon that with singing and all the people be kept no longer than an hour. Whether on the working day he preach over half an hour.

The same order limits the singing before the sermon, so that the hymns do not eat up the hour (Sehling 1, p. 370). Nassau-Weilburg 1576 does the same: at most half an hour of singing before the sermon on holy days, and a quarter on weekdays (Sehling 10, p. 229).

#### 11.7.3 Weather and work

**Shorter in the cold.** Some orders shorten the sermon for the season. At Obereisenheim the pastor is to start at eight sharp and cut the sermon shorter in winter, so that the poor and the badly clothed young people have no cause to leave the church for the cold. **Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579** (Sehling 11, p. 689):

> Es soll sich auch der pfarrer bevleißigen, wann man zuesammenleutet, daß er alsobalden in die kirchen gehe, die gesang nicht zu lang mache und gewißlich umb acht uhr anfahe zue predigen, die predigt über eine stund nicht verziehe und sonderlich winterzeit in der kälte noch mehr abkürze, hernacher auch das gebet und gesänge auch nit verlenger, damit der arme mann und die jugend, so etwas ubel bekleidet, nicht ursach haben, frost halben aus der kirche [zu laufen …]

The pastor shall also endeavour, when the bells ring together, that he go forthwith into the church, make not the hymns too long, and surely begin to preach at eight o'clock, draw out the sermon not over an hour, and especially in winter time, in the cold, cut it yet shorter; afterwards also lengthen not the prayer and hymns, that the poor man and the youth, who are somewhat ill clad, have no cause by reason of the frost [to run] out of the church […]

Troppau 1592 gives one hour in summer, three quarters in winter, and half an hour on weekdays (Sehling 3, p. 478). The weekday sermon was set early, or held only in winter, so as not to take the people from their work (§11.4.2).

#### 11.7.4 Overrunning

**Complaints.** The limits were not always kept. In 1594 the Count of Hohenlohe complained that his pastors preached far beyond the appointed time, "sometimes an hour and a half", to the annoyance of the hearers. **Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs und der Predigtlänge*, 1594** (Sehling 15, p. 639):

> sondern auch, das die predigten uber hievor verordnete zeit weits lenger und manchmals uf anderhalben stunden

but also that the sermons [have been drawn out] far longer than the time appointed heretofore, and sometimes to an hour and a half

The same command restores the limit of about three quarters of an hour (Sehling 15, p. 640). Visitors were told to ask how long the pastor preached: in Saxony in 1580 (§11.7.2), and in Hohenlohe in 1587, "how long, roughly, he letteth his sermon last" (Sehling 15, p. 532).

### 11.7.5 The limits in the orders

The table gives the limits found, by order. "Sun." is the chief Sunday or holy-day morning sermon; "afternoon" covers the midday, Vespers and catechism sermons.

| Order | Sehling | Sun. | Afternoon | Weekday | Other |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 58 | ≤ 1 h | | | |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16, p. 104 | ≤ 1 h | | | |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, p. 91 | ≤ 1 h | | | |
| Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556 | 1, p. 726 | | | early sermon ≤ ½ h | |
| Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 | 5, p. 290 | | | | funeral ≤ ½ h |
| Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562 | 13, p. 435 | about ½ h (plague time) | | about ½ h | |
| Ritschenhausen, *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562 | 2, p. 345 | ≤ ¾ h | | | |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 242 | ≤ 1 h | | | |
| Gottleuba, 1567–1577 | 1, p. 567 | about 1 h | | | |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, p. 74 | | | catechism sermons ≤ ½ h | |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572 | 13, p. 510 | ≤ 1 h | | shorter still | |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 522 | ≤ 1 h | | | |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 | 10, pp. 229, 232, 235 | ¾ h, at most 1 h | catechism ≤ ½ h | | singing before the sermon ≤ ½ h (holy days), ≤ ¼ h (weekdays) |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, p. 197 | | | | wedding and funeral about ½ h |
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577 | 20/1, p. 518 | | | | funeral ≤ ½ h |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 | 15, p. 263 | ¾ h, at most 1 h | | | |
| Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579 | 11, p. 689 | ≤ 1 h, shorter in winter | | | |

| Order | Sehling | Sun. | Afternoon | Weekday | Other |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, p. 393 | ≤ 1 h | ≤ 1 h with the singing | ≤ ½ h | |
| Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590 | 18, p. 652 | ¾ h | ½ h | ½ h | |
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591 (Reformed) | 10, p. 595 | ≤ 1 h | ½ h | ½ h | |
| Troppau (Freudenthal and Goldstein), *Kirchenordnungen*, 1592 | 3, p. 478 | ≤ 1 h summer, ≤ ¾ h winter | | ≤ ½ h | |
| Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen … der Predigtlänge*, 1594 | 15, pp. 639–640 | about ¾ h | | | |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed) | 10, p. 655 | neither under nor over 1 h | ¾ h | ¾ h | |
| Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601 | 16, p. 552 | | catechism ½ h | | |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (Reformed) | 14, p. 558 | ≤ 1 h | ≤ 1 h | ≤ 1 h | |
| Corvey (Bruchhausen), *Kirchenordnung*, 1603 | 21, p. 244 | "as briefly as may be" | | | |

## 11.8 Postils and preparation

### 11.8.1 Reading a postil from the pulpit

**Luther's advice.** A postil was a printed collection of sermons on the Sunday epistles and gospels. Luther thought it would be best to read his postil to the people. This was not only for the sake of preachers who "could do no better". It was also a guard against enthusiasts and sects, lest everyone preach what he likes, "of blue ducks" instead of the gospel. **Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, pp. 14–15):

> Und mich dunkt, wo man die deudsche postillen gar hette durchs jar, es were das beste, das man verordente, die postillen des tages ganz oder ein stucke aus dem buch dem volk fur zu lesen, nicht alleine umb der prediger willen, die es nicht besser kunden, sondern auch umb der schwermer und secten willen zuverhueten, wie man sihet und spuret an den homilien in der metten, das etwa eben auch solche weyse gewesen ist. Sonst, wo nicht geistlicher verstand und der geist selbst redet durch die prediger (wilchem ich nicht wil hiemit zil setzen; der geist leret wol bas reden, denn alle postillen und homilien), so komts doch endlich dahin, das ein iglicher predigen wird was er wil, und an stat des evangelii und seiner auslegunge widerumb von blau enten gepredigt wird.

And it seemeth to me, if one had the German postil complete through the year, it were the best that it be ordained to read to the people the postil of the day, whole or a piece out of the book; not only for the sake of the preachers who could do no better, but also to guard against the enthusiasts and sects; as one seeth and perceiveth from the homilies at Matins, that such also was once the manner. Otherwise, where spiritual understanding and the Spirit himself speaketh not through the preachers (to whom I will not hereby set a bound; the Spirit teacheth better to speak than all postils and homilies), it cometh at last to this, that every one will preach what he will, and instead of the gospel and its exposition there will again be preaching of blue ducks.

**Village pastors.** The Albertine orders of 1545 apply this to the poor village pastors. Until they can preach "out of their own understanding", they are to read from the pulpit Corvinus's postil or Luther's *Hauspostille*. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 297):

> Wo aber auf den dörfern arme einfeltige pfarern sölchs zuthun nicht vormöchten, damit sie nicht aus ihrem kopfe, eigenen tünkel oder sunst etwas irriges predigten, söllen sie für sich nehmen die postillam Corvini oder die hauspostil Lutheri und an dem sontage die auslegung des evangelii fur dem volke auf der canzel draus lesen, bis das sie aus langer ubung dermal einst auch möchten dahin kommen, das sie aus eigenem vorstande eine christliche predigt thun kunten.

But where in the villages poor simple pastors were not able to do this, lest they preach out of their own head, their own conceit, or otherwise anything erroneous, they shall take before them Corvinus's postil or Luther's house postil, and on the Sunday read out of it to the people from the pulpit the exposition of the gospel, until through long practice they also might at length come so far that they could make a Christian sermon out of their own understanding.

Many orders required every parish to own Luther's postils with the Bible and the catechisms. In the Brandenburg villages the pastor had to own the Bible, the *Hauspostille*, the catechisms and the church order (Sehling 3, pp. 153, 204).

#### 11.8.2 Against preaching from postils

**Borrowed feathers.** By the second half of the century the complaint is the opposite. Young men pass the examination by learning answers by heart, have read little of the Bible, and then "betake themselves to postils, adorn themselves with strange feathers". **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 377):

> das die jungen studiosi, so sich auf das predigampt zubegeben fürhabens, solche examina von wort zu wort oftmals nicht allein mit grossem unverstand auswendig gelernet, und, da sie mit andern worten befraget, nicht allein nichts antworten können, sondern auch mehrmals im alten und neuen testament ganz und gar nichts gelesen, welche nachmals sich auf postillen begeben, mit frembden federn schmücken, und eigener kunst oder geschickligkeit, damit sie der kirchen dienen solten, wenig bei sich haben.

that the young students who purpose to betake themselves to the preaching office oftentimes have not only learned such examinations word for word by heart with great want of understanding, and, when they are asked in other words, can answer nothing at all, but also have many times read nothing whatever in the Old and New Testament; who afterwards betake themselves to postils, adorn themselves with strange feathers, and have little art or skill of their own wherewith they should serve the church.

**Write your sermons.** Nassau-Dillenburg orders its pastors to study the Bible and to write all their sermons out, not to take them "without understanding" from the printed postils. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 110):

> Es sollen auch die pastores durch die speciallsuperintendenten zu vleißigem lesen unnd studiren in der bibeln angehalten werden, das sie auch alle ire predigten schreiben unnd solche nicht ohne verstandt hin unnd wieder aus den ausgegangenen unnd gedrucktten postillen ziehen unnd nemen, sondern vielmehr aus Gottes wortt und heiliger schrifft der propheten unnd aposteln selber.

The pastors also shall be held by the special superintendents to diligent reading and studying in the Bible, that they also write all their sermons, and draw and take them not without understanding here and there out of the published and printed postils, but rather out of God's word and the holy Scripture of the prophets and apostles itself.

**Use them, but do not lean on them.** The middle way is put most clearly in the lordship of Wolfstein. The pastor is to use "pure postils", which are named, but not rely on them wholly: they were published "not to make lazy pastors". **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 569):

> und in solcher predig sich rainer postillen als Lutheri, Philippi, Brencii, Spangenbergii, Mathesii und anderer gottseligen lehrer gebrauchen. Doch sollen sich die pfarrherrn nicht ganz und gar allain auf die postillen verlassen, sondern sollen auch selbst studiren, wie denn solche postillen nicht darumb seind publicirt worden, daß sie solten faule pfarhern machen, sondern daß die prediger und pfarhern daraus lernen sollen, wie sie die lehre göttliches worts füren und bei ihren zuhörern gebrauchen sollen.

and in such sermon make use of pure postils, as Luther's, Philip's, Brenz's, Spangenberg's, Mathesius's and [those] of other godly teachers. Yet shall the pastors not rely wholly and altogether only on the postils, but shall also study themselves; as indeed such postils were not published for this, that they should make lazy pastors, but that the preachers and pastors should learn out of them how they shall set forth the doctrine of God's word and use it among their hearers.

The Palatine visitation articles of 1594 (Reformed) ask "out of what writings and commentaries" the ministers draw and gather their sermons (Sehling 19/2, p. 822).

#### 11.8.3 Meditation and writing

**Not into the pulpit unprepared.** Late orders expect a written sermon, or at least a written outline. In Sponheim an old pastor who could not write out every sermon might keep to a written disposition of its parts. He was to show it at the ministers' conventions, to prove "that he hath not gone up into the pulpit without foregoing meditation". **Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Generalartikel*, 1608** (Sehling 18, p. 672):

> Doch wird zu gemelter inspectorn discretion gestelt, ob ein prediger etwan hohen alters halben sein verhinderung hette, daß er nit alle predigt zu concipiren vermögt, das derselbe bei schriftlicher disposition partium gelassen würde, die er bei den conventibus ufzulegen und damit zu dociren hatt, daß er nit ohne vorgehende meditation uff die Canzel gestiegen.

Yet it is left to the discretion of the said inspectors, whether a preacher, perchance by reason of great age, had his hindrance, that he could not compose all [his] sermons, [that] the same be left at a written disposition of the parts, which he hath to lay before the conventions, and therewith to prove that he hath not gone up into the pulpit without foregoing meditation.

**Assum's method.** Sehling's notes to the Hohenlohe questions of 1587 summarize the advice of the court preacher Johann Assum. The pastor is to pray, read the text diligently, and make his own thoughts on it: its argument, its division, parallels and examples from other parts of Scripture. He is then to write it out "as if he were the very first writer on the Bible", and only then read postils and amend his draft (editor's note, Sehling 15, p. 532).

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### 11.9 Rebuke, polemic and the limits of the pulpit

#### 11.9.1 Rebuke the vices, name no one

**The office of rebuke.** No order takes rebuke out of the sermon. The preacher is to rebuke sin openly; the Saxon order of 1580 calls this his *Strafamt* (§11.9.2). But he is to rebuke vices "in general" and leave persons unnamed. Private sinners are to be dealt with privately, following Matthew 18. **Merseburg, *Was den pfarhern auf itztkünftigen synodo (1545) solle angezeigt werden*** (Sehling 2, p. 26):

> und dargegen zu christlichen guten werken und wandel vormahnen, auch die laster in genere strafen durch die heilige schrift und exempel derselben, aber nimandes specifice angreifen, ader in ban zuthun sich understehen, und lestern und unartiges scheltens auf der canzel und sünst sich enthalten.

and on the other hand exhort to Christian good works and conversation, and also rebuke the vices in general by the holy Scripture and its examples, but attack no one specifically, nor take it upon themselves to put [any] under the ban, and refrain from reviling and unseemly railing in the pulpit and elsewhere.

An Augsburg preacher's contract of 1535 (Moderate Reformed) has him swear to rebuke "gently and modestly", "but neither with naming nor with pointing at particular persons". **Augsburg, *Bestallung eines Predigers*, 1535** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 46):

> daneben das ubel der notturft nach anregen, wie ainem getreuen christenlichen predicanten gezimpt, sanftmuetig und beschaidenlich strafen und von der canzel meniglich in der gemein, aber weder mit benamung noch andeutung sonderer personen vor allen falschen gotsdiensten, lastern und sunden zu der eer, auch warem dienst Gottes und allen loblichen tugenden, wie sich gepurt, ermanen

[and] besides touch upon the evil as need requireth, as becometh a faithful Christian preacher, rebuke gently and modestly, and from the pulpit exhort every one in common, but neither with naming nor with pointing at particular persons, away from all false worship, vices and sins, to the honour and also the true service of God and all laudable virtues, as is meet

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 says the same, and adds: "whereof he hath no knowledge, thereof may he be silent" (§11.6.3).

**When names were spoken.** The pulpit was used for names, but by order and not by the preacher's choice:

- **Excommunication.** Where the steps of Matthew 18 had failed, the consistory's sentence was read from the pulpit, with the name. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 245):

> so sollen sie in der kirchen oder kirchspiel, darin sie wohnen, durch eine öffentliche sentenz des consistorii von der canzel mit namen in den bann verkündiget und aus der gemeinschaft der heiligen verstossen werden.

they shall in the church or parish wherein they dwell, by a public sentence of the consistory, be proclaimed by name from the pulpit into the ban, and be thrust out of the communion of saints.

- **Banns of marriage.** Couples were "proclaimed" from the pulpit, with their parents and masters if they were strangers (§11.10.4).

### 11.9.2 No private grudges in the pulpit

**The visitors' questions.** The Saxon order of 1580 has the visitors ask how the pastor shows himself "in his office of rebuke". Does he rebuke with Christian gentleness, or "out of private affection and revenge" bring his own affairs into the pulpit and name people? **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 394):

> Wie sich der pfarrer (oder in stedten auch andere kirchendiener) in seinem strafampt erzeige, ob er mit christlicher sanftmut und guter bescheidenheit strafe, oder aus privat affection und rachgier, seine eigene sachen auf die canzel bringe, die leut namhaftig, oder sonst unvermeldet doch ausgemalet ubel ausmache, sich zu zorn bewegen lasse, scharfer, ungebürlicher, stachlichter, schmehelicher, grober wort und geberde in den predigten gebrauche.

How the pastor (or in towns also other ministers) showeth himself in his office of rebuke: whether he rebuke with Christian gentleness and good discretion, or out of private affection and revenge bring his own affairs into the pulpit, name the people, or otherwise, unnamed yet painted out, make them out evil, let himself be moved to anger, [use] sharp, unseemly, stinging, reviling, coarse words and gestures in the sermons.

Later in the same order the visitors are told that the rule against preaching against persons concerns only these "offensive sermons". It does not forbid rebuke itself (Sehling 1, p. 422).

### 11.9.3 Disputations belong in the schools

**Controversy in the pulpit.** The doctrinal quarrels of the 1550s to 1580s produced a series of mandates against "railing and condemning" from the pulpit. The Ansbach margrave told his clergy that disputations belong "in the universities, and not in the churches in the pulpit". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570*** (Sehling 11, p. 377):

> das sie sich in betrachtung ires ambts und jetziger kirchen vorstehender gelegenheit und anfechtung uf der canzel alles ergerlichen disputirens genzlich enthalten. Dann die disputationes uf die hohen schulen und nicht in die kirchen auf die canzel (aldo allein, was bauet, gelehret, aber, was abbricht und ergert, vermitten bleiben soll) gehörig, wie dann auch ohne das nichts so einfeltig fürgebracht, das nit etwo von etzlichen in mißverstand gezogen wurdet.

that, in consideration of their office and of the present state and assault of the church, they refrain wholly in the pulpit from all offensive disputing. For the disputations belong in the universities and not in the churches in the pulpit (where only what buildeth up should be taught, but what breaketh down and offendeth should be avoided); as indeed, even without that, nothing is set forth so simply that it be not drawn by some into misunderstanding.

**Princes against condemnation.** The princes of the Lower Saxon Circle, meeting at Lüneburg in 1562, forbade "unseemly railing and reviling in the pulpit". They also forbade the condemnation of others "who have not yet been heard nor ever convicted", on pain of banishment. **Lower Saxon Circle, *Abschied des Lüneburger Kreistages*, 1562** (Sehling 23, p. 177):

> Wann dann das ungebürliehe Schelten und Lestern auf der Cantzel, auch Condemnirung anderer Leute, die noch nicht gehöret noch jemals überwunden seyn, frommen und christlichen Predigern nicht gezimet, auch solch Vornement nicht allein wider Gottes Befehl und die christliche Liebe ist, sondern vielmehr dadurch grosse Widerwärtigkeit und Mißtrauen zwischen hohen und niedern Personen, auch Verachtung aller Religion entstehet

Whereas then the unseemly railing and reviling in the pulpit, and also the condemning of other people who have not yet been heard nor ever convicted, becometh not godly and Christian preachers, and such an undertaking is not only against God's

command and Christian love, but rather great hostility and mistrust between high and low persons, and also contempt of all religion, ariseth thereby

The same year the Bremen council (Philippist) forbade railing in the pulpit and bound preaching to Scripture and the Augsburg Confession (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 540). Johann Casimir's Reformed government in the Palatinate issued a mandate "against condemnations" in 1584 (Sehling 14, p. 512). In 1609 Duke Johann Adolf of Gottorf forbade "unedifying school questions" in sermons, on pain of loss of office (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 23, pp. 323–324). The Upper Palatine *Generalanweisung* of 1598 (Reformed; §11.6.3) begins its rule on plain preaching with the same complaint: preachers who angered themselves "in so holy a place" over matters of the schools.

**No politics.** Some orders also kept the preacher out of the business of the magistrate. The Colmar preachers' oaths of 1575, 1590 and 1615 forbade reviling anyone in the pulpit for their views on disputed questions. They also bade the preachers abstain from "political matters and administrations" and not disparage the council (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 479).

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## 11.10 Around the sermon: prayer, greeting, confession, intercession and notices

### 11.10.1 The medieval pulpit office

**What the reformers inherited.** Sehling's editor sets out the background in a note to an early East Frisian order, Norden's of 1528 (Reformed). Long before the Reformation the preacher said a group of vernacular pieces from the pulpit, mostly after the sermon:

- intercessions, or bidding to intercession;
- the Lord's Prayer and the Creed;
- in many places the open confession (*Offene Schuld*) with absolution;
- from the thirteenth century also the Ten Commandments and the *Ave Maria*;
- "interjections and announcements".

The orders of the Reformation kept this group around the sermon. They dropped the *Ave Maria* and turned the rest into the prayer before the sermon and the confession, general prayer and notices after it (editor's note, Sehling 7/1, p. 431).

### 11.10.2 The prayer before the sermon

**An exhortation to pray, and a hymn or the Our Father.** The preacher goes up, exhorts the people to pray for the Holy Spirit and for the fruit of the Word, and a prayer follows. Often it is the Lord's Prayer, said or sung, or the hymn "Nun bitten wir den heiligen Geist" (see Chapter 8 §8.10.1). At Nördlingen the first stanza of "Nun bitten" opened the sermon with the Lord's Prayer. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen* (Caspar Löner), 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 319; dated 1555 in the running head):

> Nun bitten wir den Hailigen Gaist, auf der canzel anzufahen, das erste gesetz mit dem Vater unser zum anfang der predig, welche aus des sontags evangelion oder des feiertages allzeit geschehen soll.

"Now pray we the Holy Ghost", the first stanza, to be begun in the pulpit, with the Our Father, at the beginning of the sermon, which shall always be made out of the gospel of the Sunday or of the holy day.

In Kurland the preacher might intone the Lord's Prayer from the pulpit and let the whole congregation sing it, "as is customary in many evangelical churches of the German nation". **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 92):

> Dar man auch den text des vater unsers für der predige bisweiln auf der canzel wil intonirn, und der ganzen gemeine singen lassen, wie sonst in vielen evangelischen kirchen deutscher nation gewönlicher

Where one will also sometimes intone the text of the Our Father before the sermon in the pulpit, and let the whole congregation sing it, as is otherwise customary in many evangelical churches of the German nation

### 11.10.3 The greeting

**The apostolic greeting.** The Palatine order of 1601 (Reformed) prescribes a fixed opening for every sermon: the apostolic greeting, in one of two forms. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 558):

> Gemeiner eingang aller predigten. Gnad, fried und barmhertzigkeit von Gott, dem vater, und seinem geliebten sohn Jesu Christo, unserm herrn, sampt der gemeinschaft des heiligen geistes sey mit uns allen, Amen. Oder also: Die gnad unsers herrn Jesu Christi und die liebe Gottes und die gemeinschaft des heiligen geistes sey mit euch allen, Amen, 2.Corint. 13. V. 13.

The common entrance of all sermons. Grace, peace and mercy from God the Father and his beloved Son Jesus Christ our Lord, together with the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with us all. Amen. Or thus: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the love of God, and the communion of the Holy Ghost, be with you all. Amen. 2 Corinthians 13, verse 13.

#### 11.10.4 After the sermon: confession, intercession and notices

**The order of the pulpit.** In many southern and western orders the sermon is followed, still in the pulpit, by:

1. an exhortation to prayer;
2. the open confession of sins and the absolution or "comfort";
3. the general prayer, with particular intercessions for the sick, for those in trouble and for newly married couples;
4. the notices: banns, feasts of the coming week, alms.

**Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 522):

> Nach vollendtem gesang gehet der Pfarrer uff die Cantzel, facht mit dem gebett die predig an, liset dann den Text des Evangelii und erclerets nach seiner gaab und der zuhörer gelegenheit, doch nit uber ein stundt. Unnd sollen sich die Pfarrer befleissigen, die fürnembste Locos communes in den sontags predigen durch das jahr dem volckh aigentlich und verständtlich auß Göttlicher schrifft zu erklären. Nach der Predig (dieweil als dann die anzahl des volckhs am grösten) vermahnet er zum gemeinen gebett, thut die offentliche gemein bekhantnus der sünden sampt dem Trost und vergebung der sünden, wie hiebevor verzaichnet fol. Erzehlet darnach allerlay anligende noth, darfür nöttig zu pitten, dessgleichen wann newe Eheleuth verhannden oder für Kranckhe, betrüebte personen zu pitten

When the hymn is ended the pastor goeth up into the pulpit, beginneth the sermon with prayer, then readeth the text of the gospel, and explaineth it according to his gift and the condition of the hearers, yet not over an hour. And the pastors shall endeavour to explain to the people, properly and understandably, out of the divine Scripture, the chief *loci communes* in the Sunday sermons through the year. After the sermon (because then the number of the people is greatest) he exhorteth to the common prayer, maketh the public common confession of sins together with the comfort and forgiveness of sins, as is set down before, folio […]. Thereafter he recounteth all manner of present need for which it is needful to pray, likewise when there are newly married folk, or [when there is need] to pray for the sick [and] troubled persons

Note the reason given for placing the confession and prayer **after** the sermon: "because then the number of the people is greatest". Many came late, after the opening hymns and lessons.

At Corvey the sermon is followed in the pulpit by the exhortation to the communicants, the confession and absolution, and the general prayer. Banns and other notices "may be done in this place". **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 244):

> 9. Wann die Predigte geschlossen ist, geschicht eine kürtze erinnerung und vermahnung an die Communicanten. 10. Darauff volget die Confeßion, Beicht und bekendtnis der Sünden und die Absolution, loßkündigung oder ledigsprechung von Sünden, in massen die hernach verzeichnet seind. 11. Endlich wirt mit gewöhnlichem, für aller Stende notturfft oder gantzen Christenheit Gebett beschlossen, und werden diese stücke allesampt auff dem Predigstull verrichtet, und da etwa Personen, so sich Ehlich vertrawet, auffzuruffen oder sonst etwas in gemein anzuzeigen und zuverkündigen were, das möcht an diesem orth geschehen.

9. When the sermon is closed, a short reminder and exhortation to the communicants is made. 10. Thereupon followeth the confession, shrift and acknowledgement of sins, and the absolution, release or loosing from sins, in such manner as they are written hereafter. 11. Finally [it] is closed with the customary prayer for the need of all estates or of the whole of Christendom; and these pieces are all performed upon the pulpit; and if perchance persons who have betrothed

> themselves in marriage were to be called, or anything else to be shown and proclaimed in common, that might be done in this place.

**A prayer of repentance from the pulpit.** Schaumburg ordered a set prayer of repentance and forgiveness to be recited from the pulpit after the main Sunday sermon. It was not meant to replace private confession. **Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 117):

> Unnd ob wir wol ein Christlich Gebet von Buß und Vergebung der Sünde, wie nachfolgen wird, welches unsere Pastores im gantzen Lande alle unnd jede Sontage nach gehaltener hohen Vormittags Predigt öffentlich von der Cantzel recitiren sollen, haben angeordnet, So sol dannoch dasselbe keines weges zu auffhebung itzermelter hochnützlichen privat Confession gemeint seyn

And although we have ordained a Christian prayer of repentance and forgiveness of sin, as shall follow, which our pastors in the whole land shall recite publicly from the pulpit every Sunday after the high forenoon sermon is held, yet shall the same in no wise be meant for the abolishing of the aforesaid most profitable private confession

**Banns from the pulpit.** Prussia requires the pastor to name strangers' parents, masters and homes in the banns "from the pulpit", so that any impediment may come to light. **Prussia, *Kirchen ordnung und ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 93):

> wo die personen unbekannt weren, wie gemeiniglich die dienstboten sind, soll der pfarrherre nicht allein ihre namen und zunamen, sondern auch ire eltern, land- und hausherren, bei denen sie dienen, nennen und in der abkündigung eigentlich von der kanzel namhaft machen.

where the persons were unknown, as commonly the servants are, the pastor shall name not only their names and surnames, but also their parents, country and the masters with whom they serve, and make them known particularly in the announcement from the pulpit.

The texts of the general prayers said from the pulpit are given family by family in Chapter 6. The hymns sung after the sermon ("Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" and others) are in Chapter 8 §8.11.

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## 11.11 Preachers: trial sermons, practice and censure

### 11.11.1 Who preached

**Pastor, deacons, chaplains.** In the towns the preaching was shared out by the order. The pastor took the chief Sunday sermon; the deacons or chaplains took the early, afternoon, weekday and hospital sermons (§11.4.1, §11.4.2). Funeral and wedding sermons often went by turn, or to whichever minister the family asked for (Sehling 3, pp. 218, 290). The village pastor preached everything himself. Schoolmasters and students did not preach in the orders' regular services. The question of who might preach at all, and on whose call, belongs to ordination and is outside this chapter; see Chapter 16 §16.5.1 for the deacons.

### 11.11.2 The trial sermon

**Examination, then a trial sermon.** From mid-century a candidate for a parish was examined in doctrine and then had to preach a **trial sermon** (*Probpredigt*). It showed whether he could teach, exhort and comfort out of Scripture, and how he spoke. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 412):

> Nach dem examen, wo der examinatus wol geantwort, soll im auch eine probpredig zu thun auferlegt werden, daraus unsere kirchenräthe zu sehen und abzunemen, wie er auß der schrift das gemeine volck leren, zur besserung vermanen und trösten könne, und auß allen umbstenden, dergleichen dem aussprechen und verstendtlicher deutscher sprach und action besser urtheilen mögen, welcher ort ime zu befelhen. So sollen auch die mengel so an im befunden, ime freuntlich undersagt und er, die zu verbessern, vermanet werden.

After the examination, if the examinee hath answered well, a trial sermon also shall be laid upon him to do, from which our church councillors may see and gather how he can teach the common people out of the Scripture, exhort [them] to amendment and comfort [them]; and from all the circumstances, likewise from the utterance and the intelligible German speech and action, may the better judge what place is to be committed to him. And the faults that are found in him shall be told him in a friendly manner, and he be exhorted to amend them.

In Osnabrück the order of steps was: the testimonial of the call shown to the superintendent; examination by the ministers; a trial sermon in St Mary's; and then ordination with the laying on of hands "after the form which Doctor Martin Luther set" (*Agende* of 1588, as printed 1618; Sehling 7/1, p. 287). The trial sermon appears in the same way in Saxony 1580 (Sehling 1, p. 380), Pfalz-Neuburg 1576 (Sehling 13, p. 172), Wolfstein 1574 (Sehling 13, p. 567) and the Calenberg-Göttingen visitation instruction of 1588 (Sehling 6/2, p. 883).

The examination and trial sermon before ordination are treated in Chapter 15, §15.7.3.

### 11.11.3 Practice sermons and censure

**Practice for pastors already in office.** In Albertine Saxony the superintendents were to have the town and country clergy preach in turn on weekdays in the towns. They set them texts from the Psalms or Paul some days in advance, and repeated the exercise according to each man's diligence. **Albertine Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion von 1577*** (Sehling 1, p. 349):

> Das auch die pfarhern und diacon uf dem lande und in stedten zum studieren und fleiss erwegt werden, so sollen unsere superintendenten und adiuncten dieselbten nach der ordenung in den stedten in der wochen predigen lassen, ihnen etliche tage zuvor materias aus den psalmen, epistolis Pauli oder sonsten aus der bibel, davon zu predigen, geben und darnach eines jeden fleiss oder unfleis erfunden wird, solche ubung wiederholen.

That the pastors and deacons in the country and in the towns also be stirred to study and diligence, our superintendents and adjuncts shall let them preach in order in the towns in the week, give them some days before matters out of the Psalms, the Epistles of Paul or otherwise out of the Bible, to preach upon; and thereafter, as each man's diligence or negligence is found, repeat such exercise.

Ansbach made the same rule for its chapters in 1565 (Sehling 11, p. 350).

**A sermon criticized by colleagues.** The Palatine classical conventions of 1587 (Reformed) made such criticism systematic. At each convention one minister preached. He then withdrew, and the others were asked in turn what faults they had found and how they might be amended. The order gives a checklist for the critics. **Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Classicalconvente*, 1587** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 530):

> Hierauf soll der kirchendiner, so die predig gehalten, zu einem abtritt angemanet und die andere befragt und nacheinander angehört werden, was sie an deß abgetretenen predig vor mengel und, wie eß zu verbessern. Alhie son alles, was zuo rechten und erbaulichen predigten gehöret, examinirt werden alß ungeverlich, ob er in demselbigen zu weitleufig und ob eß accomodatum, ob er recht den textum partirt, ob er scopum textus assequirt oder sonsten frembde questiones tractirt, so eygentlich auß dem text nicht genomen werden, ob er die partes, so er zu tractiren proponirt, recte persequirt, ob er nicht, in dem ein theil der predig sich so lang ufhalte, daß er die andere, wie verheissen, nicht außfüren möge, ob er auch langsam, bedächtlich und verstendiglich dem gemeinen mann zur erbauung die sachen vortrag und nicht die wordt eilents ubereinander werfe, ob er auch gut deutsch fürnemlich und nicht niderlendische phrases gebrauche, ob er alleß mit einem christlichen eyver proponir, auf das meniglich sein ernst verneme, er sichs und seine zuhörer excitiren konne

Hereupon the minister who hath held the sermon shall be bidden to withdraw, and the others asked and heard one after another, what faults they [find] in the sermon of him that hath withdrawn, and how it is to be amended. Here shall all be examined that belongeth to right and edifying sermons, as for example: whether he be too long-winded therein, and whether it be fitted [to the hearers]; whether he hath rightly divided the text; whether he attaineth the scope of the text, or otherwise treateth strange questions which are not properly taken out of the text; whether he rightly pursueth the parts which he proposed to treat; whether he, by staying so long on one part of the sermon, may not carry out the others as promised; whether he also set forth the matters slowly, deliberately and understandably to the common man for edification, and throw not the words hastily one upon another; whether he also use good German chiefly, and not Netherlandish phrases; whether he propound all with a Christian zeal, that every one may perceive his earnestness [and] he may stir up himself and his hearers

The list continues with whether he brought private matters into the pulpit. The "Netherlandish phrases" probably reflect the ministers from the Netherlands then serving in the Reformed Palatinate. Hanau-Münzenberg (1600, Reformed) summoned the country preachers in turn, the youngest first, every fortnight or month, to preach the weekday sermon. Afterwards the consistory told each one what was lacking in his sermon "in formalibus et doctrinalibus" (Sehling 10, p. 536).

## 11.12 Hearers

### 11.12.1 Attendance

**A duty, enforced.** The orders treat hearing the sermon as a duty of every household. It was enforced by the parish officers and by fines. Late in the century the weekday sermons in particular were poorly attended (§11.4.2). The Ysenburg counts required at least one person from every house at every weekday sermon. The mayor (*Schultheiß*) and the church wardens counted the people after the sermon and fined those absent. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 638):

> Es soll auch bey allen Wochenpredigten auß jederm Hauß zum wenigsten eine Person erscheinen, darauff der Schultheis und die Kirchen Ruger gute achtung geben, nach gehaltener Predigt umbzehlen lassen unnd die außbleibenden zu gebührlicher obangedeuter Straffe bringen sollen

At all weekday sermons also at the least one person out of every house shall appear; whereto the mayor and the church wardens shall give good heed, have [the people] counted after the sermon is held, and bring those who stay away to the due penalty indicated above

Church attendance as a duty of the laity is treated in Chapter 15, §15.8.1, and the enforcement of rest on holy days in Chapter 12, §12.11.2.

### 11.12.2 Taverns, markets and games during the sermon

**The first visitations.** The first Saxon visitors already found people walking in the market and round the church during the sermon, and going off to the beer houses and the brandy. **Ernestine Saxony, *Verordnungen aus der Visitation von 1528*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 177):

> Weiter kombt seinen c. g. vor, das die underdanen das wort gottes zum teil unfleissig horen sollen, gehn ufm markte und umb die kirche, geben also andern auch ergernus und ursache darzu, auch gehen sie zum teil under der predigte in die bierheusser und zum gebranten weine, uf dieselbigen sal man achtung haben

Further it cometh before his Electoral Grace that the subjects in part hear the word of God negligently, walk on the market and about the church, and so give offence and occasion thereto to others also; also some of them go during the sermon into the beer houses and to the burnt wine; on these heed shall be given

**Innkeepers forbidden to serve.** The remedy was to shut the inns for the length of the sermon. **Ernestine Saxony, *Pollizei und landsordnung* of the dukes Johann Friedrich the Middle, Johann Wilhelm and Johann Friedrich the Younger, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 229):

> Uf das auch diejenigen, so die wein oder bier zechen unter den predigten pflegen zu besuchen, dazu desto weniger ursach haben mügen, so wöllen wir, das hinfürder ein jeder, so wein oder bier schenkt, unter der predigt, und solange dieselbige wehret, es seivor oder nachmittage, keine geste setzen noch setzen lasse.

That those also who are wont to frequent the wine or beer taverns during the sermons may have the less occasion thereto, we will that henceforth every one that poureth wine or beer set no guests, nor let [them] be set, during the sermon and so long as it lasteth, be it before or after noon.

The same rules recur through the century: no shops open, no trading, no games, no dancing and no labour service (*Fron*) during the sermon. The Albertine articles of 1557 tell the pastor to rebuke such disorders from the pulpit, and the judges to fine the offenders (Sehling 1, p. 325). A Palatine mandate of 1592 (Reformed) complains that labour service was called out on holy days and prayer days and during the weekday sermon (Sehling 19/2, p. 785).

### 11.12.3 Chattering, sleeping, leaving early

**Fines in the church.** The Ysenburg-Ronneburg discipline order of 1591 (Reformed) fines those who chatter or sleep during the sermon, leave before it ends, or come late. It sets the length of the sermon in the same breath. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 595):

> So jemandt under der predig schwetzet oder schläffet oder in der predig (so des sontags den morgen nicht uber ein stundt, nach mittag aber unnd zur wochenpredig ein halbe stundt wehren soll) nicht zu ende verharret, es sey dann leibs schwacheit oder andere erhebliche ursachen vorhanden, auch nicht zu rechter zeit nach vollendtem leuden erscheinet, solle des sontags 6 ß unnd die wochenpredig 4 ß erlegen.

If any one chatter or sleep during the sermon, or abide not to the end in the sermon (which on Sunday in the morning shall last not over an hour, but in the afternoon and at the weekday sermon half an hour), unless bodily weakness or other weighty causes be present, or appear not at the right time when the ringing is ended, he shall pay six shillings on Sunday and four shillings for the weekday sermon.

**Stay to the end.** Leaving after the sermon, before the Supper and the prayers, was a common complaint. The orders tell the preachers to exhort the people often to stay until the whole service is done. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 58):

> Von vermanung an das volk, das es bis zu end bei der gemaind beleibe. Und sollen die prediger das volk mit allem fleiß oft ermanen, das es bei ainander bleibe, bis also das gebet, gesang und die hailige sacrament gar verrichtet sein, mit getreuem erinnern, wie uncristenlich das seie, nicht in aller andacht mit den andern cristen und der ganzen kirchen den Herren umb gemaine notturft anruefen

Of exhortation to the people that they remain with the congregation to the end. And the preachers shall with all diligence oft exhort the people that they remain together until the prayer, the singing and the holy sacrament be wholly performed; with faithful reminder how unchristian it is not to call upon the Lord, in all devotion, with the other Christians and the whole church, for the common need

Corvey 1603 gives the same charge (Sehling 21, pp. 244–245). Pfalz-Veldenz moved the confession and general prayer to after the sermon "because then the number of the people is greatest" (§11.10.4). That shows the reverse problem: many people came only for the sermon.

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## 11.13 Table by order

**Key.**

- **Sunday**: the sermons of a Sunday or holy day, and their texts.
- **Week**: the weekday sermons.
- **Length**: the limit for the chief sermon; other limits in the Notes.
- **?**: not stated in the passages read.

| Order | Vol. | Sunday | Week | Length | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts*, 1523 | 1 | Mass and Vespers, each with a sermon | daily lesson and exposition, morning and evening | ? | no gathering without the Word |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | early: epistle; Mass: gospel; Vespers: OT in course | ? | Passion: an hour a day | pericopes kept; postil may be read |
| *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 | 1 | morning gospel; afternoon catechism | Wednesday and Friday | ? | repentance with faith |
| Schlieben, 1529 | 1 | ? | Thursday, not midsummer or midwinter | ? | catechism through the year |
| Reutlingen, c. 1531 | 17/2 | ? | villages: weekly in winter | ? | catechism four times a year |

| Order | Vol. | Sunday | Week | Length | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, 1533 | 1 | ? | Monday, Tuesday, Thursday, Friday | ? | |
| Augsburg, 1535–1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h | no names in rebuke; stay to the end |
| Württemberg, 1536 | 16 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h | the common man as a sick man |
| Schleswig-Holstein, 1542 | 23 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h | prayer, text, exposition; no names |
| Wurzen, 1542 | 2 | ? | ? | ? | repentance, law and gospel |
| Nördlingen, 1544 | 12 | gospel | ? | ? | "Nun bitten" and Our Father before the sermon |
| Merseburg, 1545 | 2 | ? | ? | ? | vices *in genere* |
| Albertine Saxony, *Cellische Ordnungen*, 1545 | 1 | ? | ? | ? | village pastors read Corvinus or the *Hauspostille* |
| Zwickau, 1556 | 1 | ? | early sermon Tuesday, Friday, Saturday | early sermon ≤ ½ h | for servants and craftsmen |
| Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel*, 1557 | 1 | morning gospel; afternoon catechism | once | ? | epistle moved to weekday in farming places |
| Mecklenburg, *Conformitas*, c. 1560 | 5 | ? | ? | ? | funeral ≤ ½ h |
| Lower Saxon Circle, 1562; Bremen, 1562 (Philippist) | 23; 7/2.2 | ? | ? | ? | against railing and condemning |
| Ritschenhausen, 1562 | 2 | festivals and Sundays | Wednesday and Friday | ≤ ¾ h | prayer, text, summary, doctrines, application, repetition |
| Kurpfalz, 1563–1564 (Reformed) | 14 | ? | ? | ? | funeral: no praise; trial sermon |
| Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h | teach, reprove, comfort; prayer days |
| Gottleuba, 1567–1577 | 1 | gospel | Wednesday | about 1 h | summary, propositions, repetition |
| Prussia, 1568 | 4 | ? | catechism sermons | catechism ≤ ½ h | banns from the pulpit |
| Ansbach, 1570 | 11 | ? | ? | ? | disputations belong in the schools |

| Order | Vol. | Sunday | Week | Length | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nassau-Dillenburg, 1570 | 10 | ? | ? | ? | sermons to be written, not taken from postils |
| Regensburg, 1572 | 13 | morning sermon | weekday sermons | ≤ 1 h | weekday shorter still |
| Oldenburg, 1573 | 7/2.1 | ? | ? | ? | funeral sermon from Spangenberg and Mathesius |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574 | 18 | gospel; *loci communes* through the year | ? | ≤ 1 h | confession and prayer after the sermon |
| Wolfstein, 1574 | 13 | early sermon | Friday | ? | pure postils, but study too |
| Rötha, 1574 | 1 | morning gospel twice; afternoon catechism | Wednesday: books in course | ? | Passion in Lent |
| Torgau, 1575 | 1 | early sermon: gospel | Thursday: catechism | ? | Small Catechism every quarter |
| Aschersleben, 1575 | 2 | ? | ? | ? | funeral and wedding sermons abolished |
| Nassau-Weilburg, 1576 | 10 | ? | ? | ¾ h, at most 1 h | catechism ≤ ½ h; singing limited |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, 1576 | 13 | ? | ? | ? | wedding and funeral ½ h; trial sermon |
| Hohenlohe, 1578 | 15 | appointed gospels | ? | ¾ h, at most 1 h | Württemberg wording |
| Castell (Obereisenheim), 1579 | 11 | begins at 8 | ? | ≤ 1 h | shorter in winter |
| Albertine Saxony, 1580 | 1 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h; weekday ≤ ½ h | postils and "strange feathers"; private grudges |
| Coburg synod, 1580 | 1 | ? | ? | ? | Passion in three sermons |
| Henneberg, 1582 | 2 | ? | Wednesday | ? | six Passion sermons in Lent |
| Kurpfalz, *Classicalconvente*, 1587 (Reformed) | 14 | ? | Thursday or Friday at the convention | ? | sermon censured by colleagues |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, 1588 | 10 | ? | one person from each house | ? | counted after the sermon |
| Sponheim, 1590 | 18 | early ¾ h | ½ h | ¾ h | |
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, 1591 (Reformed) | 10 | ? | ? | ≤ 1 h; afternoon and weekday ½ h | fines for chatter, sleep, leaving |

| Order | Vol. | Sunday | Week | Length | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Troppau, 1592 | 3 | ? | ? | 1 h summer, ¾ h winter | weekday ½ h |
| Hohenlohe, 1594 | 15 | ? | ? | about ¾ h | complaint of 1½ h |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, 1598 (Reformed) | 10 | early: gospel; afternoon: catechism | Wednesday early | 1 h | ¾ h otherwise |
| Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), 1598 (Reformed) | 13 | ? | ? | ? | fitted to the hearers; no school quarrels |
| Anhalt, 1599 (Reformed) | 2 | ? | ? | ? | wedding sermon short and chaste |
| Kurpfalz, 1601 (Reformed) | 14 | at 8 | ? | ≤ 1 h | apostolic greeting; prayer-day sermons |
| Corvey (Bruchhausen), 1603 | 21 | sermon in the Mass | ? | "as briefly as may be" | doctrine, terror, comfort; pulpit acts |
| Sponheim, 1608 | 18 | ? | ? | ? | written sermon or outline |
| Schaumburg, 1614 | 7/2.2 | ? | ? | ? | prayer of repentance from the pulpit |

## 11.14 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Von ordenung gottis diensts in der gemeine*, 1523 | 1, p. 2 | 2 | 11.3.1 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, pp. 13–16 | 3 | 11.3.2, 11.4.4, 11.5.1, 11.8.1 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528 | 1, pp. 152, 168 | 9 | 11.3.3 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Verordnungen aus der Visitation von 1528*, 1529 | 1, p. 177 | 11 | 11.12.2 |
| Schlieben, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Schlieben*, 1529 | 1, p. 659 | 129 | 11.4.2 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die Stadt Wittenberg*, 1533 | 1, p. 701 | 148 | 11.4.1 |
| Wurzen, *Gemeine Artikel*, 1542 | 2, p. 96 | 1223 | 11.6.2 |
| Merseburg, *Was den pfarhern auf itztkünftigen synodo (1545) solle angezeigt werden* | 2, p. 26 | 1212 | 11.9.1 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545 | 1, p. 297 | 33 | 11.8.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ernestine Saxony, *Pollizei und landsordnung*, 1556 | 1, p. 229 | 22 | 11.12.2 |
| Zwickau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1556 | 1, p. 726 | 155 | 11.4.2, 11.7.5 |
| Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557 | 1, pp. 323, 325 | 37 | 11.4.1, 11.12.2 |
| Ritschenhausen (Henneberg), *Gottesdienst-Ordnung*, 1562 | 2, p. 345 | 1249 | 11.6.1, 11.7.5 |
| Gottleuba, *Verzeichnus der kirchenordnung zur Gotleuben*, 1567–1577 | 1, p. 567 | 87 | 11.6.1, 11.7.5 |
| Rötha, *Kirchen-Ordnung für Rötha*, 1574 | 1, p. 653 | 125 | 11.5.2 |
| Torgau, *Verordnung der Visitatoren von 1575* | 1, p. 683 | 141 | 11.4.3 |
| Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575 | 2, p. 481 | 1260 | 11.4.6, 11.4.7 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Visitations-Instruktion von 1577* | 1, p. 349 | 40 | 11.11.3 |
| Coburg, *Beschlüsse des coburgischen Synodus*, 1580 | 1, p. 255 | 26 | 11.4.4 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 370, 377, 380, 393, 394, 422 | 44 | 11.7.2, 11.7.4, 11.7.5, 11.8.2, 11.9.2, 11.11.2 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchen ordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582 | 2, p. 313 | 1247 | 11.4.4 |
| Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1599 (Reformed) | 2, p. 582 | 1263 | 11.4.7 |

**Franconia, Swabia, Alsace and the Palatinates**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Reutlingen, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1531 | 17/2, p. 42 | 827 | 11.4.2, 11.4.3 |
| Augsburg, *Bestallung eines Predigers*, 1535 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 46 | 336 | 11.9.1 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16, p. 104 | 651 | 11.7.1, 11.7.5 |
| Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 58 | 338 | 11.7.1, 11.7.5, 11.12.3 |
| Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien in der pfarkirchen zu Sant Georgen*, 1544 | 12, p. 319 | 373 | 11.10.2 |
| Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562 | 13, p. 435 | 446 | 11.7.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 (Reformed) | 14, p. 406 | 504 | 11.4.6 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564 (Reformed) | 14, p. 412 | 504 | 11.11.2 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565 | 11, p. 350 | 283 | 11.11.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Begleitschreiben zur Konkordie von 1570* | 11, p. 377 | 290 | 11.9.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572 | 13, p. 510 | 452 | 11.7.1, 11.7.5 |
| Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574 | 13, pp. 567, 569 | 463 | 11.8.2, 11.11.2 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 522 | 1011 | 11.5.3, 11.7.5, 11.10.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, pp. 172, 197 | 404 | 11.7.5, 11.11.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1577 | 20/1, p. 518 | 1336 | 11.7.5 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 (and Sehling's notes) | 15, pp. 248, 263 | 574 | 11.5.1, 11.7.1, 11.7.5 |
| Castell, *Dorfordnung für Obereisenheim*, 1579 | 11, p. 689 | 315 | 11.7.3, 11.7.5 |
| Öhringen, *Befehl nach der Visitation*, 1581 | 15, p. 427 | 586 | 11.4.6 |
| Kurpfalz, *Mandat gegen Kondemnationen*, 1584 (Reformed) | 14, p. 512 | 507 | 11.9.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Fragen über die Kirchenzeremonien*, 1587 (and Sehling's notes on Assum) | 15, p. 532 | 602 | 11.7.4, 11.8.3 |
| Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Classicalconvente*, 1587 (Reformed) | 14, p. 530 | 510 | 11.6.3, 11.11.3 |
| Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590 | 18, p. 652 | 1020 | 11.7.5, 11.13 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1, p. 430 | 1090 | 11.4.6 |
| Kurpfalz, mandates on the prayer days and the *Polizeiordnung*, 1591–1592 (Reformed) | 19/2, pp. 777, 780, 785 | 1151, 1152, 1153 | 11.4.5, 11.12.2 |
| Kurpfalz, *Generalvisitationsinstruktion*, 1594 (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 822 | 1162 | 11.8.2 |
| Hohenlohe, *Befehl wegen des Kirchengesangs und der Predigtlänge*, 1594 | 15, pp. 639–640 | 627 | 11.7.4, 11.7.5 |
| Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Generalanweisung*, 1598 (Reformed) | 13, p. 349 | 427 | 11.6.3, 11.9.3 |
| Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601 | 16, p. 552 | 713 | 11.7.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1601 (with the variants of 1563) (Reformed) | 14, pp. 557–558 | 515 | 11.5.2, 11.7.5, 11.10.3 |
| Sponheim (Hintere Grafschaft), *Generalartikel*, 1608 | 18, p. 672 | 1021 | 11.8.3 |
| Colmar, preachers' oaths, 1575–1615 (Sehling's introduction) | 20/2, p. 479 | 1407 | 11.9.3 |

**Hesse, Nassau and the Wetterau**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 242, 260 | 2257 | 11.4.5, 11.6.2, 11.7.5 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1570 | 10, p. 110 | 180 | 11.8.2 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 | 10, pp. 229, 232, 235 | 198 | 11.7.2, 11.7.5 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1588 | 10, p. 638 | 229 | 11.12.1 |
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1591 (Reformed) | 10, p. 595 | 222 | 11.7.5, 11.12.3 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 (Reformed) | 10, p. 655 | 231 | 11.7.5 |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, order of 1600 (Reformed) | 10, p. 536 | 211 | 11.11.3 |

**Brandenburg, Silesia, Prussia, Mecklenburg and Kurland**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Gardelegen (Sehling's introduction) | 3, p. 218 | 1766 | 11.4.6, 11.11.1 |
| Bagow, *Visitations-Abschied und Matrikel*, 1553; Brandenburg town order of 1551 | 3, pp. 153, 204 | 1754, 1763 | 11.8.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Salzwedel (Neustadt), order of 1579 | 3, p. 290 | 1780 | 11.11.1 |
| Troppau, *Kirchenordnungen für Freudenthal und Goldstein*, 1584–1592 | 3, p. 478 | 1824 | 11.7.3, 11.7.5 |
| Mecklenburg, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 | 5, p. 290 | 1936 | 11.4.6, 11.5.3, 11.7.5 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und ceremonien*, 1568 | 4, pp. 74, 93 | 1833 | 11.7.5, 11.10.4 |
| Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570 | 5, p. 245 | 1926 | 11.9.1 |
| Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, p. 92 | 1907 | 11.10.2 |

**Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the North**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| East Frisia, Norden, 1528 (Reformed) (editor's note on the medieval pulpit office) | 7/1, p. 431 | 2111 | 11.10.1 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, p. 91 | 1576 | 11.6.3, 11.7.5, 11.9.1 |
| Lower Saxon Circle, *Abschied des Lüneburger Kreistages*, 1562 | 23, p. 177 | 1582 | 11.9.3 |
| Bremen, *Mandat zum Verbot des Scheltens auf der Kanzel*, 1562 (Philippist) | 7/2.2, p. 540 | 2223 | 11.9.3 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1109 | 2151 | 11.4.6 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1065 | 2058 | 11.4.7 |
| Osnabrück, *Agende* (1588), 1618 | 7/1, p. 287 | 2101 | 11.11.2 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1588 | 6/2, p. 883 | 2040 | 11.11.2 |
| Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1590 | 22, p. 480 | 1536 | 11.4.6 |
| Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603 | 21, pp. 244–245 | 1455 | 11.6.1, 11.7.5, 11.10.4, 11.12.3 |
| Gottorf, *Predigtmandat*, 1609 (Sehling's introduction) | 23, pp. 323–324 | 1613 | 11.9.3 |
| Schaumburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1614 | 7/2.2, p. 117 | 2178 | 11.10.4 |

# Chapter 12. The Liturgical Calendar

This chapter covers the church year in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks:

- **Which days did the orders keep, and why?** What principles decided which feasts stayed, and which went?
- **How were the feasts ranked?** What happened to the medieval grades (*summum*, *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*), to octaves, vigils and the transfer of feasts?
- **How was a feast kept in church?** What special rubrics, chants, ceremonies and services did the high feasts have, and what was abolished?
- **How was a feast kept in common life?** What rest from work did the orders require, how was it enforced, and what became of markets, weddings, guild feasts and the folk festivals of the year?
- **How were the seasons kept?** Were there more services in Advent, Lent and Holy Week? What became of Rogation week and the Ember days? Which seasons were closed to weddings?
- **What fasts were kept, by whom, where and why?**

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §12.1 summarizes the findings, and §12.2 sets out the sources and method.
- §§12.3–12.9 deal with the feasts themselves:
  - §12.3, why feasts were kept at all;
  - §12.4, the medieval grades;
  - §12.5, the Lutheran scale of feasts;
  - §12.6, whole and half holy days;
  - §12.7, the following days of the high feasts;
  - §12.8, individual feasts;
  - §12.9, the *Vierzeiten*.
- §12.10 covers the ceremonial marks of the feasts in church, the festal ceremonies that were abolished, and the seasonal changes in the service.
- §12.11 covers the keeping of holy days in common life.
- §12.12 covers the seasons: Advent, Lent, Holy Week, Rogation week, the closed seasons and the Ember days.
- §12.13 covers fasting.
- §12.14 deals with occurrence and transfer, and §12.15 with the short calendars of the Upper German towns and the Reformed.
- §12.16 is a concordance of every order quoted.

Each topic is supported by quotations in the original language (Early New High German, Low German or Latin), each followed by an English translation.

## 12.1 Summary of findings

### 12.1.1 The main findings

**1. The medieval grades did not survive as grades of feasts.**

- No order ranks a feast as *duplex*, *semiduplex* or *simplex*, and none has a system of Office grades (§12.4.1).
- The old vocabulary survives in fragments:
  - *summum* and *minus summum* as names of Kyrie melodies (Pomerania 1542, Buxtehude 1565, Nördlingen 1544, Hof 1592);
  - *summa festa* as a name for the highest feasts (Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587);
  - the ferial, dominical and festal forms of the Office in chapters and convents;
  - the adverbs *ferialiter*, *festive* and *solenniter*;
  - *per anticipationem* for moving a feast forward (§§12.4.2–12.4.6, 12.14.2).
- Octaves have gone; the "following days" of the high feasts take their place (§12.7). So have vigil fasts; first vespers on the eve take their place (§12.4.6).

**2. The ranking is theological.** The orders rank feasts by what they commemorate:

- the feasts of Christ, and above all his birth, resurrection and the sending of the Spirit;
- then the days whose "history is written in the Gospel": the Purification, the Annunciation, John the Baptist, the Visitation;
- then the apostles, kept for their example;
- then nothing, for feasts that rest on legend (Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary).

The formula "nicht umme der dage willen, sonder umme der historien willen" (Bugenhagen, §12.3.3) states the test. Luther's *Formula missae* of 1523 gives its first form (§12.3.1).

**3. The rank is kept by civil and ceremonial means.** Most orders do not tell the ranks apart by the liturgical form of the service. They do so by:

- whether work is forbidden all day, until noon, only during the sermon, or not at all (§12.6);
- how many sermons are preached (§12.6.3);
- how many days the feast lasts (§12.7);
- a set of ceremonial marks (§12.10): Latin chant, the grade of the Kyrie, proper prefaces, sequences, figural music and organ, vestments and elevation, bells, the Athanasian Creed, communion, and bans on weddings, markets and guild feasts (§12.11.3).

**4. The usual scale has three ranks below Sunday** (§12.5.1):

- the high or chief feasts of Christ;
- a second rank of other Gospel feasts (John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and often Purification and Annunciation);
- the apostles' days as half holy days.

Some orders draw two ranks only (Luther, Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed), and in effect the Reformed orders of §12.15). Others number three classes (Grubenhagen 1544, Regensburg 1567, Hoya 1571, Harlingerland 1573/74). Sayn 1582 has four, the fourth being the abolished feasts (§12.5.5). Danzig and Thorn speak of "great" and "small" feasts (§12.5.6).

**5. The families of orders follow their models.**

- **Saxon and Mecklenburg family** (§12.5.2). Saxony 1539 and Mecklenburg 1552 set the pattern: "hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi" first, then "uber diese furnemsten fest" the apostles, John, Visitation and Michaelmas, kept in the forenoon. It was taken up across the north and in Pfalz-Zweibrücken.
- **Württemberg family** (§12.5.3). Holy days are proclaimed by the magistrate. At first there is one list, later divided into whole days and forenoon days.
- **Bugenhagen family** (§12.5.4). "The three great feasts of Christ" are kept three full days each. The other Gospel feasts are also kept fully. The apostles are moved to the next Sunday.

**6. Whole and half holy days** (§12.6). From the 1560s the orders of the Harz, Hesse, the Rhine and the Main set out day-by-day tables of whole and half days: Mansfeld 1580, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Landau 1562, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574, Ysenburg 1582, Nassau-Weilburg 1609 and 1618, Solms 1603. Harvest, markets and craftsmen's work pushed the summer feasts down to half days or onto Sundays. The Transylvanian synod of 1578 has the technical term: the apostles' days are kept *intercise*, "by halves" (§12.6.4).

**7. The middle rank is where the orders differ most** (§12.8).

- **Michaelmas.** It rose to be one of the four chief feasts in the north, in place of the Assumption (§12.8.5, §12.9).
- **The Assumption.** It was abolished in most orders. In Franconia and Tecklenburg it was kept "for the working country-folk" but preached as the Visitation (§12.8.3).
- **The Visitation.** It was moved to 15 August in the Nürnberg family (§12.6.4).
- **Purification and Annunciation.** Everywhere they are treated as feasts of Christ, but their rank ranges from whole holy day to half day (§12.8.1).

**8. The *Vierzeiten*** (§12.9). In north Germany the top rank had a fiscal name: the four feasts (Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, formerly the Assumption) on which the "four-times penny" was paid. The payment made the rank, and the rank carried liturgical marks:

- a sermon at first vespers (Wolfenbüttel 1543);
- a Latin Mass (Hoya 1571);
- proper prefaces (Lippe 1571).

**9. Occurrence and transfer** (§12.14). The orders keep simple rules of precedence:

- A feast of Christ on a Sunday displaces the Sunday Gospel; an apostle's day yields to it.
- An apostle's day on a Saturday goes to the Sunday.
- The Annunciation in Holy Week is moved in at least six different ways.

Some orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority.

**10. The minimum** (§12.15). The Upper German cities (Mülhausen 1529, Reformed; Augsburg 1537, Esslingen 1537 and Strasbourg 1544, Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed territories (Kurpfalz 1563, Nassau-Dillenburg 1582, Anhalt 1599) kept only Sunday and a few feasts of Christ, which reduced the ranking to Luther's two ranks. Esslingen's return to the apostles' days after the "blue Mondays" of 1537 shows how unstable that minimum was.

**11. Feasts in church** (§12.10). Besides the marks of rank, the orders abolished the acted ceremonies of the medieval year: the Palm Sunday ass, the Good Friday grave, the Easter image, the Ascension figure, the Whitsun dove, the Christmas cradle, and all processions with holy water, crosses and the sacrament (§12.10.10). Some orders kept seasonal changes in the chant: the plain Kyrie and no *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, the Creed for "Nun bitten" in Advent (§12.10.11).

**12. Feasts in common life** (§12.11).

- **Rest in three degrees.** Sunday and the high feasts were kept wholly. The lesser holy days were kept until noon, or only during the sermon (§12.11.1).
- **Enforcement** was by the magistrate: town gates shut on holy-day mornings, fines, taverns closed, horses unharnessed (§12.11.2).
- **Weddings, guild feasts and markets** were moved away from the high feasts (§12.11.3).
- **The folk festivals** were attacked as "heathen" in mandate after mandate: *Fastnacht*, *Kirchweih*, Walpurgis and May, the Whitsun ales, the Midsummer fires and the *Hagelfeier* (§12.11.4).
- **Shrove Sunday** was turned by Bugenhagen into a feast of baptism (§12.11.5).

**13. The seasons** (§12.12).

- **Luther** would not show off Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday "with other rites" than the rest of the year (§12.12.1).
- **Lent** kept its name and became a season of preaching:
  - repentance and the Passion;
  - more weekday sermons;
  - a daily catechism at the hour of the old *Salve Regina*;
  - Sunday examinations before the Easter communion.

  There was no daily Lenten Mass (§12.12.3).
- **Advent** was kept for preaching on the prophecies and the Last Day (§12.12.2). **Holy Week** was kept for the Supper on Maundy Thursday and the Passion on Good Friday (§12.12.4).
- **The catechism seasons.** Rogation week, Advent, Lent and harvest became Bugenhagen's four catechism seasons (§12.12.5).
- **Closed seasons.** Weddings were still forbidden in Advent and Lent and at the high feasts, for a new reason: they drew people from the sermon (§12.12.6).

- **The Ember days** lost their fast but kept their dates. They became the quarter days for payments, catechism series, the Litany, ordinations and the reading of ordinances (§12.12.7).

**14. Fasting** (§12.13).

- **The obligation abolished.** The fixed fasts (Lent, Fridays, Ember days, vigils) were abolished as obligations binding the conscience. Fasting was still praised as good "to tame the body" and was to last "the time of our life" (§12.13.1).
- **Exhorted, but free.** The earliest orders exhort the people to keep the old fast days freely (§12.13.2).
- **The old fasts kept.** A few, such as Waldeck 1528 and the Catholic Margrave of Baden, kept the old fasts (§12.13.3).
- **Civil abstinence.** Magistrates ordered meat-free days for economic reasons and said so: the Nordhausen police order of 1549, which exempts the old, the sick, labourers, children and women in childbed (§12.13.4).
- **The new fasts** were appointed days of fasting and prayer in time of war, plague and danger, and fasting before the choice of ministers (§12.13.5).
- **Before communion.** The one regular fast was the communicant's: the sacrament received fasting, and no banquets on the eve of Sundays and feasts (§12.13.6).

### 12.1.2 What became of the medieval categories

| Medieval category | In the evangelical orders | § |
|---|---|---|
| *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*, *totum duplex* | not found as grades of feasts | 12.4.1 |
| *summum*, *minus summum*, *paschale*, *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *feriale* (Kyrie and Gloria melodies) | kept as chant grades in some orders; *summa festa* as the name of the top rank | 12.4.2, 12.10.2 |
| *festum fori* / *festum chori* | replaced by whole and half holy days, and by days kept "without a commanded holy day" | 12.5.2, 12.6 |
| nine lessons and three lessons | three-lesson matins the norm; nine lessons in some chapters; three lessons for high feasts in villages | 12.4.3 |
| proper and common of saints | proper Office for high feasts; *commune sanctorum* for saints' days in convents | 12.4.4 |
| octaves | not kept; forbidden for saints (Ansbach 1533); St Stephen's octave abolished (Mülhausen 1524, Reformed); replaced by the two or three "following days" | 12.4.4, 12.7, 12.15 |
| vigils | vigil fasts abolished; first vespers on the eve, with confession, and on higher feasts a sermon | 12.4.6 |
| occurrence and transfer | simplified rules of precedence and transfer, including *per anticipationem* | 12.14 |
| patronal and local feasts | abolished, turned into thanksgivings, or kept with a sermon (Wied 1564, Reformed) | 12.4.5, 12.8.9 |

### 12.1.3 Terms of rank used in the orders

| Term | Meaning in the orders | Examples (§) |
|---|---|---|
| *hohe Feste*, *hohe heubtfest des herrn Christi*, *Hauptfeste* | the highest rank: the feasts of Christ, or the three or four great feasts | Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2); Henneberg 1582 (12.6.3) |
| *de dre groten feste Christi* | Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide | Braunschweig 1528, Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (12.5.4) |
| *vier Zeiten*, *veer tide*, *vier hochzeitliche feste*, *Vierzeitenfest* | the four chief feasts on which the four-times penny was paid | Lübeck 1531, Waldeck 1525, Hoya 1571 (12.9) |

| Term | Meaning in the orders | Examples (§) |
|---|---|---|
| *summa festa*, *summae festivitates*, *in summis festis* | the highest feasts | Hadersleben 1528, Tangermünde 1603, Gottorf 1587 (12.4.2) |
| *fürnembste*, *furnemliche*, *vornemlichste Feste* | the chiefest feasts (often the whole list of holy days) | Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2), Württemberg 1553 (12.3.5), Northeim 1539 (12.3.5) |
| *andere herliche fest* | the second rank | Grubenhagen 1544 (12.5.5) |
| *mittelmeßige festa* | middle feasts, kept as half days | Sayn 1582 (12.5.5) |
| *gemeine Feste*, *gemeine Feiertage* | common feasts: the lower ranks | Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (12.6.2), Henneberg 1582 (12.6.3) |
| *große* and *kleine Feste*, *kleine oder halbe feste* | great and small feasts | Danzig 1612, Thorn 1575 (12.5.6) |
| *ganz*, *halb gefeiert*; *bis Mittag*; *vormittag*; *bis die Sermon geendet* | whole and half holy days | 6 |
| *ohne gebotene Feier* | declared, but without commanded rest | Merseburg 1544 (12.5.2) |
| *ungefeiret in gedechtnus* | remembered, but not kept holy | Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (12.5.7) |
| *solenniter*, *festive*, *festivaliter* | in solemn, festal manner | Schwarzburg 1587 (12.7.1), Leisnig 1529 (12.4.5), Pomerania 1569 (12.10.2) |
| *ferialiter* | (a) in the weekday form, without *Gloria*; (b) as a holiday | Anhalt 1551, 1568; Wied 1564 (Reformed) (12.4.5) |
| *intercise*, *dimidiatim* | by halves | Mediasch 1578 (12.6.4) |
| *per anticipationem* | moved back before its date | Wintzingerode (12.14.1) |
| *de tempore*, *de festo*, *commune sanctorum* | the proper of the season or feast; the common of saints | Mecklenburg 1552 (12.5.2), Crevese 1541 (12.4.4) |

## 12.2 Scope, sources and method

### 12.2.1 The corpus

The corpus is Sehling's edition, volumes 1–24, as held in `eko.db`. It has 2,350 document records in 30 digitized volumes and half-volumes, with Sehling's own subject registers linked to the pages. The edition prints church orders, agendas, visitation instructions and recesses, parish reports and council decrees. It also prints editorial introductions and notes. This chapter quotes only the sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century texts. The editors' notes are cited as such where they matter.

### 12.2.2 How the corpus was searched

Every document was scanned with regular expressions for the groups of terms below. Matches were read in context, and then the full passages were pulled from the relevant orders.

- **Medieval grades and rubrical terms.**
  - *summum*, *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*, *totum duplex*, *triplex*, the abbreviations *dupl.* and *semidupl.*;
  - *festum fori*, *festum chori*;
  - *novem* / *tres lectiones*;
  - *classis*, *festivitas*, *solemnitas*;
  - *festive*, *solenniter*, *ferialiter*;
  - *commune sanctorum*, *octava*, *vigilia*;
  - *per anticipationem*, *transferre*.

- **German and Low German terms of rank.**
  - *hohe*, *höchste*, *große* and *kleine Feste*, *Hauptfest*, *fürnembste Feste*;
  - *halbe* and *ganze Feiertage*, "bis Mittag", "vormittag";
  - *Aposteltage*, *Marienfeste*, the "third day";
  - *gebannte Feiertage*, *verlegen*, *verschieben*, and their Low German forms (*vyrdage*, *hochtide*, *veer tide*).
- **Ceremonial markers.**
  - the *Vierzeiten* and the four-times penny;
  - the Kyrie grades (*summum*, *paschale*, *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *festivale*, *feriale*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magnae Deus*) and the *Benedicamus* grades;
  - proper prefaces;
  - bells and chiming (*beiern*).
- **The names of the feasts themselves.** These were searched in lists and in rules for transfer.
- **The seasons and fasting** (added for the fuller calendar):
  - *Advent*, *Fasten*, *vasten*, *Quadragesima*, *Marterwoche*, *Gründonnerstag*, *Karfreitag*, *Kreuzwoche*, *Bittwoche*, *Hagelfeier*;
  - *Quatember*, *Fronfasten*, *quatertemper*;
  - *fleisch essen*, *Fasttag*, *Bußtag*, *nüchtern*;
  - *Fastnacht*, *vastelavend*, *Aschermittwoch*;
  - *Hochzeit* with *Advent* and *Fasten*.
- **Holy days in common life.** *Sonntag* and *Feiertag* with *arbeit*, *fahren*, *kaufen*, *kram*, *zechen*, *tanzen*; *Kirchweih*, *Kirmes*; *Walpurgis*, *Johannisfeuer*, *Meyen*; the festal ceremonies (*Palmesel*, *Kindelwiegen*, *Auffahrt*, *Tauben*).

Sehling's subject registers were also used: *Feiertage* (380 page references), *Festtage* and *Festtage/-Zeiten* (377), *Aposteltage* (135), *Feiertagsordnung* (77), *Vigilien* (95), *Marienfeste* (27).

**Related chapters.**

- Chapter 8 covers the hymns of the seasons and feasts, the *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, and the *Leisen* of the high feasts.
- Chapter 4 covers the proper prefaces, sequences and the propers of the feasts.
- Chapter 5 covers the collects of the seasons and the Lenten *super populum* prayers.
- Chapter 10 covers Vespers and the eves of feasts.
- Chapter 11 covers Passion, prayer-day and catechism sermons and the duties of hearers.
- Chapter 13 covers the rites of the feasts and seasons, and the Litany days (§§13.21, 13.22.4).
- Chapter 9 covers the organ and the bells (§§9.3.6, 9.5).
- Chapter 14 covers vestments and colours (§§14.6.6, 14.7).
- Chapter 2 covers the Kyrie and the Gloria by season (§§2.6.2, 2.7.1).
- Chapter 15 covers the catechism seasons as times of instruction (§15.11.1).

### 12.2.3 Cautions

- **Record headings and dates in the database.** A database record often holds more than one order, and its year field can be wrong. In this chapter every order is named from the running head of the page on which the quotation stands. Some examples:
  - The Henneberg record is dated 1555 in the database but holds texts from 1545 to 1582. The feast rules are in the *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst of 1582.
  - The Danzig record contains the St Mary's order of 1567, the church fathers' compilation of 1612, and several Elbing and Thorn texts, among them the Thorn order of 1575.
  - A record among the East Frisian orders, dated 1593 in the database, holds on the pages quoted the Harlingerland order of 1573/74.
  - The Sayn record labelled "1314" holds the *Kirchenzuchtordnung* of 1582 and the *Kirchenordnung* of 1590.
  - The Mansfeld feast lists belong to the *Kirchen-agenda* of 1580.
  - The Anhalt record holds orders from 1532 to 1572.
- **Editorial summaries and apparatus.** A few texts are quoted from the editors' apparatus, not the main text, and are marked as such:
  - Saxony 1539 is printed partly as a summary with quotations.

    - Variants: Nassau-Weilburg's *Agende* of 1618, Brenz's recension B, the German text B of the Burzenland articles, and the Latin report of the Mediasch synod.
- **Two-column prints.** Where the edition prints in two columns, the digitized text sometimes interleaves them. The Danzig list of 1612 and the Schwarzburg list of 1587 are examples. Quotations skip the interleaved matter and mark the gap with "[…]".
- **Silence.** When an order does not mention a feast, it is not always abolished. Many orders list only the days that are holy days. Days kept "ungefeiret in gedechtnus", in memory but without rest, often go unnamed.

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## 12.3 Why keep feasts at all: the principles behind the ranking

Before an order ranks feasts, it usually says why any feast besides Sunday should be kept. Its answer decides the ranking:

- **The feasts of Christ.** Those that set forth the work of redemption come first.
- **Feasts with a Gospel history.** Feasts whose history is told in the Gospel come next.
- **The apostles and the rest.** The apostles, and other days kept only for their examples, come last.
- **Legend and abuse.** Feasts with no ground in Scripture, or bound up with abuse, are abolished.

The passages below give the main forms of the argument.

### 12.3.1 Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523

**Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Primo, introitus dominicales et in festis Christi, nempe paschatis, pentechostes, nativitatis, probamus et servamus, quamquam psalmos mallemus, unde sumpti sunt, ut olim, sed nunc sic usui recepto indulgebimus. Quod si qui apostolorum, virginis aliorumque sanctorum introitus (quando e psalmis aut aliis scripturis sumpti sunt) probare volent, non damnamus. Nos Wittembergae solis dominicis et festis domini sabathissare quaeremus, omnium sanctorum festa prorsus abroganda, vel si quid dignum in eis est, in dominicalibus concionibus miscenda esse putamus. Festum purificationis et annunciationis pro festis Christi, sicut epiphanian et circumcisionem, habemus. Loco festi S. Stephani et Iohannis Evangelistae officium nativitatis placet. Festa S. Crucis anathema sunto. Alii faciant pro sua conscientia vel aliorum infirmitate, quod spiritus suggesserit.

First, the introits of the Sundays and of the feasts of Christ, namely of Easter, Pentecost and the Nativity, we approve and keep, although we had rather have the psalms from which they are taken, as of old; but now we will bear with the received use. And if any will approve the introits of the apostles, of the Virgin, and of other saints (when they are taken out of the psalms or other Scriptures), we condemn them not. We at Wittenberg seek to keep sabbath only on the Lord's days and the feasts of the Lord; the feasts of all the saints we judge are to be utterly abrogated, or, if there be aught worthy in them, to be mingled into the Sunday sermons. The feast of the Purification and of the Annunciation we hold for feasts of Christ, as also the Epiphany and the Circumcision. In the stead of the feast of St Stephen and of John the Evangelist, the office of the Nativity pleaseth us. The feasts of the Holy Cross, let them be anathema. Let others do according to their own conscience, or for the infirmity of others, what the Spirit shall suggest.

**Note.** This is the charter of the Lutheran calendar. It sets out four points:

- **Two ranks only.** Sundays and "feasts of the Lord" are kept, and nothing else.
- **Marian feasts reclassified.** The two Marian feasts with a Gospel history, the Purification and the Annunciation, are counted as feasts of Christ.
- **Stephen and John absorbed.** Their days are taken into Christmas.
- **Holy Cross.** The feasts of the Holy Cross are damned outright.

The last sentence leaves room for local custom, and most later orders used it. They kept the apostles, the Visitation, John the Baptist and Michaelmas at a lower rank.

### 12.3.2 Homberg, 1526: only the mysteries of redemption

The Homberg synod's *Reformatio* is a Moderate Reformed order of Philip of Hesse's church.

**Hessen, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae* (Homberg), 1526, cap. 8** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 49):

> De festis et commemorationibus cap. 8 [38] Praeter Dominicam diem nullum festum celebretur, nisi pro mysteriis nostrae redemptionis. Adeo haec sola de caetero habeantur: Nativitatis Christi, Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Praesentationis Domini in templum, Incarnationis Verbi Dei sive Annuntiationis, diei Parasceves, Paschae die primo, Ascensionis et Pentecostes die primo, item dies Visitationis Beatae Mariae. […] Horum quippe celebratio non in factis superstitiosis, sed in verbi sancti frequentia et operibus misericordiae est sita.

Of feasts and commemorations, chapter 8. [38] Beside the Lord's day let no feast be celebrated, save for the mysteries of our redemption. Wherefore let these only be kept henceforth: of the Nativity of Christ, of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Presentation of the Lord in the temple, of the Incarnation of the Word of God or Annunciation, of the day of the Preparation, of Easter the first day, of the Ascension, and of Pentecost the first day; item the day of the Visitation of the Blessed Mary. […] For the celebration of these standeth not in superstitious deeds, but in the frequent use of the holy Word and in works of mercy.

**Note.** This is the strictest one-rank calendar of any Lutheran-leaning order in the corpus:

- **Nothing between Sunday and the feasts of redemption.** There are no apostles, no John the Baptist and no Michaelmas.
- **One day each.** Easter and Pentecost are kept for their "first day" only.

The Homberg *Reformatio* was never put into force. The later Hessian orders (also Moderate Reformed) keep more (§§12.3.5, 12.3.6).

### 12.3.3 "Not for the days' sake, but for the histories": Bugenhagen

**Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

> Wy sind vor Gade in unsen conscientien an neyne tidt vorbunden, overs sulck schüt deme gemeynen volke to denste, dewile alle stucken der hilgen scrift up eyne tidt nicht gehandelt konen werden. Darumme holde wy ock de hogen feste Christi unde andere, darvan in deme evangelio historien synt bescreven, nicht umme der dage willen, welke gelden (vor Gade unde by den rechtvorstendigen Christen) like vele, de eyne so vele alse de andere, sonder umme der historien willen to predigen.

We are before God in our consciences bound to no time; but such is done for the service of the common people, forasmuch as all the parts of holy Scripture cannot be handled at one time. Therefore we keep also the high feasts of Christ, and others whereof histories are written in the Gospel, not for the days' sake, which (before God and with Christians of right understanding) are worth alike, the one as much as the other, but for the histories' sake, to preach them.

**Note.** The same words stand in Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, pp. 513–514) and, in shorter form, in the other Bugenhagen orders. The test, "whereof histories are written in the Gospel", is the one most later orders use to rank a feast.

**Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

> Van Vyerdagen. Denne wy möthen etlike Feste beholden, nicht um der dage willen, sonder van wegen der Predige des Gödtliken wordes, dat alle stücke des Hilligen Evangelii mögen bequemlick uthgelecht werden. Wy nemen nene vyerdage an, den allene de gewöntlike Sondage, Darmede men van dem arbeide rouwen, dat Word Gades hören, Dat Sacrament entfangen unde ynt gemene vor alle nodturfft bidden, ock Gade vor syne woldadt dancken mögen.

Of holy days. For we must retain certain feasts, not for the days' sake, but because of the preaching of the divine Word, that all the parts of the holy Gospel may be conveniently expounded. We accept no holy days save only the wonted Sundays, whereon men may rest from labour, hear the Word of God, receive the Sacrament, and pray in common for every need, and also thank God for his benefits.

### 12.3.4 A school timetable of doctrine

**Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 164):

> Welche feste also geordnet sind, denn man kann “nicht alle stücke des evangelii einmals leren. Darümb man solche lere ins jar geteilet hat. Wie man in einer schule ordnet, auf einen tag Virgilium, auf den andern Homerum zu lesen.

Which feasts are so ordained because one cannot teach all the parts of the Gospel at once. Therefore such doctrine hath been divided through the year, as in a school one ordaineth to read Virgil on one day and Homer on another.

The Württemberg order has the feasts of Christ follow the order of his acts. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 105):

> Haben wir für gut angesehen, das man ein fest nach dem andern begee unnd in den festen Christi eben die ordnung halte, die in den thaten selbs, natürlicher ordnung und übernatürlicher götlicher anschikkung unnd würckung nach, sich von anfang der empfencknus unnd menschwerdung Christi, unsers liebsten heilands, uns zu erlösung unnd ewiger herrlicheyt so gnedigklich eines nach dem andern erzeiget hat.

We have thought it good that one feast be kept after another, and that in the feasts of Christ that very order be held which, in the deeds themselves, according to the natural order and to the supernatural divine appointment and working, hath shewn itself so graciously one after another, from the beginning of the conception and incarnation of Christ our dearest Saviour, unto our redemption and eternal glory.

#### 12.3.5 Not a commandment of God: a civil and pastoral ordinance

**Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

> Bey den kristen ist kein eusserlicher, von Got gebotner Feyertag, wie by den Juden der Sabath und ander Festen gewesen sein, sonder ist ein stetter, ewiger Sabbath oder Feyertag, vom Tauff anhebend, biß in den tod werdendt, darin nimer kein unrecht gescheft volnbracht sol werden. Doch in einer cristenlichen versamlung zur eusserlichen noturfft mag ein ordnung in tagen und Zeytten mit Feyertagen und wercktagen gehalten werden in zuchtiger ordnung und eusserlicher ainikait, nit zu einem gewißen, als von Got gebotten und zur frumckait und selsellikait notig

Among Christians there is no outward holy day commanded of God, as the Sabbath and other feasts have been among the Jews; but there is a continual, everlasting Sabbath or holy day, beginning from baptism and lasting unto death, wherein no unrighteous business shall ever be performed. Yet in a Christian congregation, for outward necessity, an order in days and times, with holy days and working days, may be kept in seemly order and outward unity; not for the conscience, as commanded of God and needful to godliness and salvation

**Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon on the magistrate's ordinance of holy days, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 78):

> Est autem regia via festos non existimare necessarios esse ad felicitatem eternam, sed ad honestam civilem pacem et concordiam ac quietem a labore. Quod enim caret alterna requie, durabile non est. Atque hac via incedit mandatum magistratus civilis de festis. Ordinavit enim dies festos non ad iusticiam divinam necessarios, sed ad publicam pacem et quietem, ut hec sit civilis ordinacio, non papatus supersticio.

Now the royal way is to hold feast days not necessary to eternal felicity, but to honest civil peace and concord and to rest from labour. For that which lacketh alternate rest is not durable. And in this way goeth the commandment of the civil magistrate concerning feasts. For he hath ordained feast days not as necessary to divine righteousness, but for the public peace and quiet, that this may be a civil ordinance, not a superstition of the papacy.

**Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 934):

> Wiewol es unnötig ist, viel festtage anzurichten, und auch aus kraft christlicher freiheit niemand an solche feirtage gebunden sein sol, wie die epistel zun Colossern am andern bezeugt, so hat man dennoch umb der schwachen willen, dieweil das evangelion bey uns noch etlichermasse neue ist, etliche furnemliche feste, damit das wort deste statlicher getrieben und gehort werde, verordnen müssen.

Although it is needless to set up many feast days, and no man also ought to be bound to such holy days, by virtue of Christian liberty, as the epistle to the Colossians in the second chapter witnesseth; yet for the weak's sake, forasmuch as the Gospel is among us yet in some measure new, certain principal feasts have had to be ordained, that the Word may be the more worthily set forth and heard.

The Hessian order of 1532 (Moderate Reformed) also justifies the apostles' days by the need for rest. **Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 75):

> Nicht sagen wir, daß dise tage besser oder heiliger seint dan andere, sonder daß solchs des gemeinen mans und der ungelerten jugent, dermaßen furgnomen, hohe notturft erfordert, welches sonst, durch ihre arbeit verhindert, nicht zeit haben, zum weinigsten die notturftigest stuck christelichs glaubens zu leren; uberdas ist auch sonst bruderlich und civile, daß man beide, menschen und viehe, zun zeiten ihre reuw lasse.

We say not that these days are better or holier than others, but that the great need of the common man and of the unlearned youth, taken in this wise, requireth it; who otherwise, hindered by their labour, have no time to learn at the least the most needful parts of the Christian faith. Moreover it is also otherwise brotherly and civil that both men and cattle be let have their rest at times.

The Württemberg preamble of 1553 was copied into the Kurpfalz order of 1556, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Nördlingen 1579 and others. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

> Dieweil dann die ordnung der Feyertag gmeiner Kirchen dahin dienstlich, das sie bestimpte zeit wisse, die Predig und die außtheilung der Heiligen Sacrament zu besuchen, und die gemeinen, weltlichen Recht zubeweisung ires gehorsamen diensts gegen Christo, dem Son Gottes, und seiner Kirchen ire besondere freiheit den fürnembsten Feirtagen geben, So wöllen wir, das hie nachbenannte tag zu Feirtag verkündiget und Christlich gebür nach gehalten werden

Forasmuch then as the order of holy days serveth the common Church to this end, that it may know an appointed time to resort to the sermon and to the ministering of the holy Sacraments; and the common temporal laws, to shew their obedient service toward Christ the Son of God and his Church, give their special freedom to the chiefest holy days: we will that the days hereafter named be proclaimed for holy days, and kept according to Christian duty

#### 12.3.6 "The feast of all feasts": Hessen, 1566

**Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 257–258):

> haben wir uns auch fürgenommen, etliche festa Christi zu halten. […] Chrysostomus […] in einer predig vom heiligen Philogonio erzelet etlich festa Christi und nennet die menschwerdung und geburt Christi das fest aller festen. Denn aus diesem haben ihren grund und ursprung Epiphania, Ostern, Himmelfart und Pfingsten.

we also have purposed to keep certain feasts of Christ. […] Chrysostom […] in a sermon on the holy Philogonius rehearseth certain feasts of Christ, and calleth the incarnation and birth of Christ the feast of all feasts. For out of this have Epiphany, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost their ground and origin.

**Note.** This is the only place in the corpus where one feast is ranked above all the others, and it is done by patristic argument. The order does not draw a liturgical consequence. Its feasts of Christ are kept "in the form of the Sunday", with only the chants, lessons and prayers changed (p. 258).

#### 12.3.7 The test of Scripture history

**Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Heinrich, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 274):

> Uber die gemeinen sontage sollen gehalten werden die hohen heuptfeste des herrn Christi, welche von alters her in der christenheit darzu geordnet sind, das die sondern stücke der historien oder geschicht von Christo, so man im glauben bekennet, in gedechtnis des gemeinen volks behalten und daran dieselben artikel des christlichen glaubens gehandelt werden. Zu solchen festen Christi gehören auch etliche von denen, so man bisher der jungfrauen Marie gefeiert hat.

Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which from of old in Christendom were ordained to this end: that the several parts of the history or story of Christ which are confessed in the Creed might be kept in the remembrance of the common people, and those same articles of the Christian faith handled thereon. To such feasts of Christ belong also some of those that were hitherto kept for the Virgin Mary.

**Note.** This paragraph, the list that follows it (§12.5.2) and the rule for the apostles' days became the model for the Mecklenburg order of 1552. Through that order it reached the Brunswick, Lüneburg, Oldenburg, Lippe, Verden and Palatinate-Zweibrücken

orders.

Pfalz-Neuburg uses the same test to decide which days break the continuous reading of Scripture. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 71):

> Doch ausgenommen die hohen fest, die ir historien, darumb sie aufgesetzt sein, in der heiligen schrift haben als Weihennacht, Obersten, Lichtmeß, Annunciationis, Palmtag, Ostern, Auffartstag, Pfingstag, Johannis des taufers, Visitationis etc.; dann an disen festen sol man die capitel aus der bibel lesen, für die epistel und evangelia, darin die historia des fests beschrieben und die sonst darzu verordnet sein.

Yet excepted the high feasts which have their histories, for the sake whereof they were set up, in holy Scripture, as Christmas, Twelfth Day, Candlemas, the Annunciation, Palm Sunday, Easter, Ascension Day, Whitsunday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, etc.; for on these feasts one shall read, for the epistle and Gospel, the chapters out of the Bible wherein the history of the feast is written and which are otherwise appointed thereto.

**Gera, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 2, p. 158; an extract of the order of the Vogtland superintendents made at Plauen in 1552):

> III. Festa und feiertage. Neben den gewönlichen sonntag sollen die feste Christi und der heiligen apostel, so evangelia und historien in der schrift geben, in allen gemeinen feierlich gehalten, daran gottes wort mit vleis gepredigt, auch das göttlich ampt mit reichung der sacrament, do communicanten vorhanden, und sonderlich der catechismus nachmittage stets getrieben werden. Es sollen aber damit diese nachvolgende und keine andere der heiligen oder sonsten papistische feste gemeint sein.

III. Feasts and holy days. Beside the wonted Sunday, the feasts of Christ and of the holy apostles which give Gospels and histories in the Scripture shall be solemnly kept in all congregations; and on them God's Word shall be diligently preached, and the divine office also held with the ministering of the sacraments, where there be communicants, and in especial the catechism be always taught in the afternoon. But hereby shall be meant these following, and no other feasts of the saints or otherwise papistical.

**Transylvania, Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543** (Sehling 24, p. 189; Latin):

> Dies festos propter multiplices abusus in angustum contraximus observatis tamen omnibus iis, qui in ecclesia generali ob historias in sacris literis comprehensas sunt recepti.

The feast days, because of manifold abuses, we have drawn into a narrow compass, yet keeping all those which have been received in the general Church for the histories contained in the holy writings.

**Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577** (Sehling 24, p. 400):

> Nolumus omnino in nostris ecclesiis ullam esse celebrandorum festorum varietatem, sed cathalogus festorum dierum in Reformatione Coronensis Ecclesiae traditus observetur. Qui vero in eo adscripti non sunt (ut puta in sacris nullam habentes historiam) omittantur.

We will in no wise that there be in our churches any variety in the feasts to be celebrated, but let the catalogue of feast days delivered in the Reformation of the church of Kronstadt be observed. But those that are not written therein (as having, namely, no history in holy writ) let them be omitted.

The Riga order gives a reason of this kind for keeping the Visitation. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

> Alle festa Christi unsers herrn und erlösers, woll wir halten, auf das man das gedechtnus der heilsamen und grossen gnadenreichen werck, die uns zu trost geschehen sind, mit predigten und ermanung des volcks jerlich begehe, als nemlichen weinachten, circumcisionis, epiphanie, purificationis, annunciationis, ostern, pfingsten, mit den andern folgenden tagen, auch ascensionis Christi, und visitationis, die weil das die erste offenbarung Christi ist gewesen, da er noch in mutter leib war

All the feasts of Christ our Lord and Redeemer will we keep, that the remembrance of the wholesome and great gracious works which were done for our comfort may be kept yearly with sermons and exhortation of the people; namely Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter, Pentecost, with the other days following, also the

Ascension of Christ, and the Visitation, forasmuch as that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb

At Regensburg the feasts that the town's Catholics still keep are dropped, because they lack a Scripture history. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 474):

> Und wiewol in unser stat die papisten viel mehr feirn halten, als Georgii, Corporis Christi, Mariae Magdalenae, Laurentii, Assumtionis Mariae, Nativitatis Mariae, Omnium sanctorum, Martini, Catharinae, Nicolai, so haben wir sie doch zu feiern entlich faren lassen und mit vorgehender, genugsamer erinnerung an die christlich gemein, wie solche fest nit allein gar kein historien heiliger schrift haben, sondern als ganz bäpstisch mit höchster abgötterei und zu bestetigung derselben, wider die reine lere unser kirchen vom widerteil gebraucht werden.

And although in our city the papists keep many more holy days, as of George, of Corpus Christi, of Mary Magdalene, of Laurence, of the Assumption of Mary, of the Nativity of Mary, of All Saints, of Martin, of Catherine, of Nicholas, yet we have at last let go the keeping of them, with foregoing sufficient admonition to the Christian congregation, how such feasts not only have no history of holy Scripture at all, but are used by the adverse part, as wholly papistical, with the highest idolatry and to the confirming of the same, against the pure doctrine of our churches.

#### 12.3.8 The Sabbath argument: Sunday first in dignity

Most Lutheran orders treat the choice of days as free. The synodal order of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), printed among the Posen texts, grounds Sunday's precedence in the moral law. **Posen, Bohemian Brethren, synodal order, 1576** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 285):

> VII. Consuetudo circa dies festos. Inter dies festos primam tribuimus dignitatem septimo diei, dominico, quem arbitramur nemini hominum ad operas externas et serviles, ullo etiam libertatis christianae praetextu adhibere licere. Idque propterea, quod institutionem eius non pro ceremonia, sed pro parte moralis, aeternum inviolabilis, legis agnoscimus.

VII. The custom concerning feast days. Among the feast days we give the first dignity to the seventh day, the Lord's, which we judge it lawful for no man to employ in outward and servile works, under any pretext even of Christian liberty; and that because we acknowledge its institution not for a ceremony, but for a part of the moral law, everlastingly inviolable.

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## 12.4 The medieval grades and what became of them

The late-medieval rite ranked a feast in two ways. The first was its liturgical grade: *totum duplex*, *duplex*, *semiduplex* and *simplex*, with *summum* or *duplex maius* at the top in many diocesan uses. The second was its civil status: a *festum fori*, on which work was forbidden, or a *festum chori*, kept only in choir. The grade decided the Office: nine lessons or three, proper or common, first vespers, an octave, the colour and the ceremony. This section asks which of these terms and categories the evangelical orders kept.

#### 12.4.1 *Duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex*: absent

No order in the corpus uses *duplex*, *semiduplex*, *simplex* or *totum duplex* as the grade of a feast. Every hit for these words is ordinary Latin. The Bohemian Brethren's order for Posen (1576, Hussite) calls certain duties *duplicia*, and the Gottorf catechism (1571) teaches a *triplex usus legis*. Neither has anything to do with feasts. There are no abbreviations such as *dupl.* or *semidupl.* either. *Festum fori* occurs only in a modern editor's note (on Nürnberg 1522). The medieval scale of Office grades did not pass into the evangelical church orders.

#### 12.4.2 *Summum* and *minus summum*: grades of the chant

*Summum* survives, but as the name of a melody, not of a feast. In the late-medieval Kyriale the Kyrie and Gloria were sung to melodies graded by rank:

- *summum* for the highest feasts, *minus summum* for lesser doubles;
- *paschale* for Eastertide, *dominicale* for Sundays;
- *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *de martyribus*, *de confessoribus*, *de virginibus* for saints' days;

- *feriale* for weekdays.

A number of Lutheran orders keep this system, and with it keep grading the day.

The Pomeranian order gives the grade of the Kyrie at Mass. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> Darup dat kyrie dominicale, efft me mach ock up die sondage, kyrie angelicum, de martiribus, effte confessoribus, efft virginibus, wo man sie genomet hefft singen, dominicale im advent und in der vasten, dat paschale tuschen pingsten und paschen, dat summum up die hohern fest, effte dat minus summum.

Thereupon the *Kyrie dominicale*; or one may also sing upon the Sundays the *Kyrie angelicum*, *de martyribus*, or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Whitsuntide and Easter, the *summum* upon the higher feasts, or else the *minus summum*.

**Note.** This is the clearest statement in the corpus of the old Kyrie grades applied by rank. The saints' melodies are now simply alternatives for ordinary Sundays. The *summum* is kept for "the higher feasts" (*die hohern fest*), and *minus summum* is offered as a lesser alternative there.

The Buxtehude *Agende* has these headings over its printed Kyrie melodies, which the editor traces to Lucas Lossius's *Psalmodia*. **Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 123):

> In summis festivitatibus et dominica Trinitatis cum textu. Minus summum. I. In festis beatae virginis Mariae. II. Kyrie paschale. Dominicale. In Adventu Domini. Angelicum Kyrie. Kyrie apostolicum. Dominicale.

On the highest festivities and on the Sunday of the Trinity, with the text. *Minus summum*. I. On the feasts of the blessed Virgin Mary. II. *Kyrie paschale*. *Dominicale*. In the Advent of the Lord. *Kyrie angelicum*. *Kyrie apostolicum*. *Dominicale*.

At Hof the grades appear in the Latin school Mass in the monastery church. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 472):

> Mox II. ex missali magno canitur Kyrie certi temporis vel angelicum in Adventu Domini vel Kyrie Magnae Deus potentiae de Nativitate Christi, cui Et in terra angelicum subiicitur, vel Kyrie dominicale maius post dominicam Septuagesimae usque ad Pascha vel Kyrie paschale vel Kyrie Fons bonitatis cum Et in terra angelico vel Kyrie dominicale minus post festum Trinitatis vel de apostolis, martyribus etc., prout tempus requirit et libri ordo monstrat.

Straightway, secondly, is sung out of the great missal the Kyrie of the proper season: either the *angelicum* in the Advent of the Lord; or the Kyrie *Magnae Deus potentiae* of the Nativity of Christ, whereunto the *Et in terra angelicum* is joined; or the greater *dominicale* after the Sunday of Septuagesima until Easter; or the Kyrie *paschale*; or the Kyrie *Fons bonitatis* with the *Et in terra angelicum*; or the lesser *dominicale* after the feast of the Trinity; or that *de apostolis*, *de martyribus*, etc., as the time requireth and the order of the book sheweth.

**Note.** At Hof the melodies are chiefly seasonal. Its German *Kirchenamt* still names them by rank all the same:

- The same Kyrie is called *angelicum seu feriale* in Advent (p. 432).
- It is called *angelicum seu festivale* on St Laurence's day (p. 445) and on the feasts of Mary (p. 450).
- The *Benedicamus* at vespers is labelled *festivale*, *dominicale*, *paschale* or *feriale* (for example "Benedicamus festivale seu feriale", p. 422).

Nördlingen reserves the *summum* for Pentecost and Trinity. **Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544** (Sehling 12, pp. 321–322):

> Zu Pfingsten. 1. Introitus de Spiritu oder Kom, hailiger Gaist. 2. Kyrie summum und Et in terra wie zu Ostern. […] De sancta Trinitate. 1. Introitus de tempore. 2. Kyrie summum mit dem Et in terra. 3. Nach der epistel, den sequenz de tempore.

At Whitsuntide. 1. The introit *de Spiritu*, or *Kom, hailiger Gaist*. 2. *Kyrie summum* and *Et in terra*, as at Easter. […] Of the holy Trinity. 1. The introit *de tempore*. 2. *Kyrie summum* with the *Et in terra*. 3. After the epistle, the sequence *de tempore*.

In Mecklenburg the grade name passes to a German Kyrie. **Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545** (Sehling 5, p. 151):

> Das düdesche kyrie summum: Ach vader, alder högeste godt, schölen de kerckheren up den dörpern singen, unde dem volke idt leren, dat de ganze kercke idt singe.

The Dutch [that is, German] *Kyrie summum*, "Ah Father, God most high of all", shall the parsons in the villages sing, and teach it the people, that the whole church may sing it.

**"The highest feasts" as a category.** Outside the chant books, *summa festa* or *summae festivitates* is used simply as the name of the top rank of days.

The Hadersleben article on Latin singing. **Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528** (Sehling 23, p. 64):

> Eth schal ock friig sin, dat sie in den groten festen mögen Gloria in excelsis up latin singen, des gelicken Alleluya und eine sequentien, alse Grates nunc omnes, Victime Paschali, Veni Sancte Spiritus, und de leyssen darinn, item dat latinische Patrem, prefatien, Sanctus unnd Agnus Dei, doch dat aleine up di groten feste.

It shall also be free that they may on the great feasts sing *Gloria in excelsis* in Latin, likewise the Alleluia and a sequence, as *Grates nunc omnes*, *Victimae paschali*, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, and the *Leisen* therein; item the Latin *Patrem*, the prefaces, the Sanctus and the *Agnus Dei*: yet that only upon the great feasts.

**Note.** In the Latin version of these articles, preserved in the edition's apparatus, this article is headed *De Latine cantionibus in summis festis*. The Low German "groten feste" and the Latin *summa festa* are the same rank.

Tangermünde's *Ritus* is a local custom-book, printed from Küster. **Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603** (Sehling 3, p. 338):

> Si summae festivitates celebrando veniunt et incipiuntur, a die solis per totam septimanam a concionandi labore feriantur ministri. 3. In summis festis diaconus, qui matutinam habet concionem, explicat textum evangelicum, pastor alium convenientem. Alter diaconus lectionem Epistolae.

If the highest festivities come to be celebrated and are begun, the ministers shall rest from the labour of preaching from the Sunday through the whole week. 3. On the highest feasts the deacon that hath the morning sermon expoundeth the text of the Gospel, the pastor another that is convenient, the other deacon the lesson of the Epistle.

**Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587** (Sehling 23, p. 371):

> 12. An Praefatio Dominus vobiscum in summis festis ante communionem cantetur et qua lingua.

12. Whether the Preface, *Dominus vobiscum*, be sung on the highest feasts before the communion, and in what tongue.

#### 12.4.3 Nine lessons and three

In the medieval Office, a feast of higher grade had a matins of three nocturns and nine lessons. A simple feast or a feria had one nocturn and three lessons. Luther's *Formula missae* already takes the three-lesson matins as the norm for ordinary days.

**Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 9):

> In reliquis diebus, quas ferias vocamus, nihil video, quod non ferri possit, modo missae abrogentur. Nam matutinae trium lectionum et horae, tum vesperae et completorium de tempore (exclusis sanctorum feriis) nihil sunt nisi scripturae divinae verba.

In the rest of the days, which we call ferias, I see nothing that may not be borne, so that the masses be abolished. For the matins of three lessons, and the hours, and also vespers and compline *de tempore* (the holy days of the saints being excepted), are nothing but the words of divine Scripture.

Pfalz-Neuburg still reckons with both forms in chapters and monasteries. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 77–78 and 95):

> Die mögen in den stiften und clöstern, da man teglich metten singt, also geordnet werden, das, wann man novem lectiones helt, drei aus den historischen büchern der bibel als Mose, Josua, Judicum, Ruth, Samuel, der Könige und Chronica, […] darnach drei aus den propheten […] Desgleichen sollen die drei metten in der marterwochen zu ir gewonlichen zeit auch nach obgemeltem unterricht, doch on alles klopfen, rumpeln und getümmel gehalten werden, allein das, wo man sie novem lectionum helt, sollen die letsten drei oder, wo man sie allein trium lectionum helt, sollen dieselben drei in den pfarrkirchen und, wo das, gemein volk darbei ist, teutsch gelesen werden

These may be so ordered in the chapters and cloisters where matins is sung daily, that when nine lessons are kept, three be taken out of the historical books of the Bible, as Moses, Joshua, Judges, Ruth, Samuel, the Kings and Chronicles, […] thereafter three out of the prophets […] Likewise the three matins in the week of the Passion shall be kept at their wonted time, and also according to the instruction aforesaid, yet without all knocking, rumbling and tumult; only that where they are kept with nine lessons, the last three, or where they are kept with three lessons only, those same three, shall be read in German in the parish churches, and where the common people are present.

In Waldeck a high feast raises the village matins by one grade. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 276):

> Früh zur Metten Sollen die Schüler mit dem Veni sancte anfangen. Volgents eyn Invitatorium und Venite, ob man kan, Darnach Antiphon und Psalmen de Dominica oder Festo, Hierauff die Lectiones und Responsoria des gemeynen Sontags und heyligentages, wie droben unter dem titel: Kirchen Ordnung auff den Dörffern, Aber auff hohe Festtage drei Lectiones und Responsoria, dem fest gemeß, Volgents Te Deum laudamus, Benedictus cum sua Antiphona, Collecten und Benedicamus singen.

Early, at matins, the scholars shall begin with the *Veni sancte*; next an invitatory and *Venite*, if it can be done; thereafter antiphon and psalms *de Dominica* or *de Festo*; hereupon the lessons and responds of the common Sunday and holy day, as above under the title "Church order in the villages"; but upon high feast days three lessons and responds, agreeable to the feast; next sing *Te Deum laudamus*, *Benedictus* with its antiphon, the collects and *Benedicamus*.

In the Transylvanian order the more solemn feasts keep a fuller matins. **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 222; Latin version):

> In solennioribus autem festis tres antiphonae cum suis psalmis retinentur. […] His succedit: Te Deum laudamus Germanicum, in maioribus festis etiam Latinum.

But on the more solemn feasts three antiphons with their psalms are retained. […] These are followed by the *Te Deum laudamus* in German, on the greater feasts in Latin also.

#### 12.4.4 Proper, common and *de tempore*

Where the Office was still sung in a chapter or convent, the orders use the old categories of the Office. These are the ferial, dominical and festal forms; the proper *de festo* against the *commune sanctorum*; the octave; and the *suffragia*.

**Goslar, collegiate church of SS. Simon and Jude, *Ordnung für das Stundengebet*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 264):

> Vesper Psalmi feriales cum una Gloria et una anthifona, dar nha lectio ex Novo testamento, inchoande in principio Mathei etc., in festo responsorium de festo, imnus ferialis aut dominicalis vel de festo, Magnificat cum anthifona feriali, in Dominica tertia anthifona ex ewangelio dominicali, in festivitatibus de festo, dar nach Kyrieleyson - Christeleyson - Kyrieleyson, Pater noster, versiculus Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam etc., collecta dominicalis vel festivalis, Benedicamus.

Vespers. The ferial psalms with one *Gloria* and one antiphon; thereafter a lesson out of the New Testament, beginning at the beginning of Matthew, etc.; on a feast the respond of the feast; the hymn ferial, or dominical, or of the feast; *Magnificat* with the ferial antiphon, on Sunday the third antiphon out of the Sunday Gospel, on festivities of the feast; thereafter *Kyrie eleison, Christe eleison, Kyrie eleison*, *Pater noster*, the versicle *Ostende nobis, Domine, misericordiam tuam*, etc., the dominical or festal collect, *Benedicamus*.

**Crevese, Benedictine nunnery, visitation recess, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 203):

> Sunst sollen ock die junkfrowen gemeinlich horas de tempore, und van hohen festen, wa bether gescheen, halden. Desgleichen, wan ein fest de sanctis kommet, sollen sie dat commune sanctorum halden und duse gesenge alle, wie in dem stift to Coln an der Sprew gesungen werd, reformert.

Otherwise also the maidens shall commonly keep the hours *de tempore*, and of the high feasts, as hitherto hath been done. Likewise, when a feast *de sanctis* cometh, they shall keep the *commune sanctorum*, and all these chants reformed, as they are sung in the chapter at Cölln on the Spree.

**Note.** Proper Offices are allowed for the high feasts. A saint's day gets only the common Office, which names no saint's legend. The same wording recurs in the other Brandenburg convent recesses (Sehling 3, pp. 219, 238, 272, 305).

At the Ansbach chapters saints' octaves and suffrages are forbidden. **Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Ordnung singens und lesens bei den Stiften*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 314):

> Alle suffragia de sanctis sollen sie underlassen; dann sie stellen das vertrauen in die hailigen wider das erst gebot Gottes. Allein mogen sie an den werktagen suffragia pro pace und pro peccatis halten. Item sie sollen auch von kainem hailigen die octava, den achtenden, halten. Die histori Trinitatis ist rain; die mögen sie halten, als sie wollen.

All suffrages *de sanctis* they shall leave off, for they set trust in the saints against the first commandment of God. Only upon the working days they may keep the suffrages *pro pace* and *pro peccatis*. Item, they shall also keep the octave, the eighth day, of no saint. The history of the Trinity is pure; that they may keep as they will.

**Note.** This is the only explicit ruling on octaves among the rank passages. Elsewhere octaves are never forbidden, but they are also simply never mentioned. The Lutheran "three days" of the high feasts (§12.7) took their place.

#### 12.4.5 *Ferialiter, festive, solenniter*

Three adverbs from the old rubrics survive: *ferialiter*, *festive* and *solenniter*. *Ferialiter* is used in two opposite senses:

- In Anhalt it keeps its medieval meaning: "in the weekday manner", without the *Gloria in excelsis*.
- In the county of Wied (Reformed) it means "as a holiday", from classical *feriae*.

Anhalt's order of the German hymns builds a three-step scale into the Mass:

- the high feasts, with sequence, *Patrem*, preface, Sanctus and *Agnus Dei*;
- other Sundays and holy days, with German hymns and Luther's exhortation;
- weekdays, *ferialiter*.

**Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before February 1551** (Sehling 2, pp. 554–555):

> an hohen festen das alleluia und sequenz, an andern sontagen ader feiertagen ein deutscher gesang [...] und volgents an hohen festen singe der priester die praefacio und die schueler das sanctus. An andern son- und feiertagen soll gelesen werden die vermanunge doctor Mart. Luthers an die communicanten. [...] Under der communion aber an hohen festen soll gesungen werden das agnus dei [...] An den werkeltagen soll es also gehalten werden. Fruehe soll eine kurze metten gesungen werden; so aber communicanten vorhanden, mag solche metten underlassen, und das ganze officium coenae in gleicher mass und gestalt, wie oben angezeigt, doch ferialiter ut vocant gehalten werden, als nemblich introitus dominicalis ader ein deutscher psalm kirieleison, doch ane gloria in excelsis

on high feasts the Alleluia and sequence, on other Sundays or holy days a German hymn [...] and then on high feasts let the priest sing the preface and the scholars the Sanctus. On other Sundays and holy days shall be read Doctor Martin Luther's exhortation to the communicants. [...] But under the communion on high feasts shall be sung the *Agnus Dei* [...] On the working days it shall be kept thus. In the morning a short matins shall be sung; but if there be communicants, such matins may be left off, and the whole office of the Supper kept in like measure and form as above shewed, yet *ferialiter*, as they call it, namely the Sunday introit or a German psalm, Kyrie eleison, but without *Gloria in excelsis*

**Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 569):

> Do aber festum annuntiationis in der marterwoche gefiele, sol mans ufn palmabend halten, visitationis und nativitatis Marie ferialiter mit den gewonlichen evangelien zu halten.

But if the feast of the Annunciation fall in the week of the Passion, it shall be kept on the eve of Palm Sunday; the Visitation and the Nativity of Mary are to be kept *ferialiter*, with their wonted Gospels.

**Note.** The Visitation and Nativity of Mary are not holy days. Their Gospels are read on the day, in the weekday form. This is the only order in the corpus that keeps the Nativity of Mary in this reduced way. Compare §12.8.4.

Wied (Reformed) has a two-column list of feasts. **Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 467):

> Sequitur catalogus festorum. ferialiter: Circumcisionis Christi Trium Regum Purificationis Mariae Annunciationis Mariae Matthiae Visitationis Mariae Pasche cum sequente proxima Ascensionis Christi Pentecostes cum sequente Iohannis Baptistae [...] Festum Nativitatis Christi cum duobus sequentibus diebus Omnium Apostolorum tantum fiet concio: Omnium Sanctorum Conversionis Pauli Marci Mariae Magdalenae Laurentii Natalis Mariae Decollationis Iohannis Michaelis Catarinae In festis patronorum cuiuslibet Ecclesiae

There followeth the catalogue of feasts. *Ferialiter* [that is, to be kept as holidays]: of the Circumcision of Christ; of the Three Kings; of the Purification of Mary; of the Annunciation of Mary; of Matthias; of the Visitation of Mary; of Easter with the next day following; of the Ascension of Christ; of Pentecost with the day following; of John the Baptist [...] the feast of the Nativity of Christ with the two days following; of all the Apostles. Only a sermon shall be held: on All Saints; the Conversion of Paul; Mark; Mary Magdalene; Laurence; the Nativity of Mary; the Beheading of John; Michael; Catherine; on the feasts of the patrons of every church.

**Note.** Sehling's editor reads the first column as the whole holy days and the second as the half holy days, kept by a morning sermon only. Two things stand out:

- **Michaelmas.** In the north it is one of the four chief feasts (§12.9). Here it is only a sermon day.
- **Patronal feasts.** The feast of each church's patron survives at the lowest grade. No other order in the corpus keeps it.

**Amt Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 610):

> Auch sollen die drei hohen feste, allwege drei tag feierlich und festive mit allen cerimonien gehalden werden, und sich sunst in allem andern des buch underricht der visitatorn gehorsamlich halden

Also the three high feasts shall always be kept three days, solemnly and *festive*, with all ceremonies; and in all else they shall keep themselves obediently to the book, the Instruction of the Visitors.

#### 12.4.6 Vigils and first vespers

The medieval vigil, with its fast and vigil office, disappears. What survives is the evening before a feast: first vespers, with confession for the next day's communicants and on the higher feasts a sermon. The name *vigilia* survives with it. So does the old rule that only feasts of some rank have a proper eve.

**Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 411):

> Ordo cantilenarum in vespertinis precibus, et quidem in specie ad omnes dies pridianos festorum (vulgus vigilias appellat), hoc est: dominicas et festa proxime praecedentes dies.

The order of chants at the evening prayers, and that in particular for all the days before feasts (the common people call them vigils), that is, the days next going before Sundays and feasts.

**Lohr (county of Rieneck), *Vesperordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 11, p. 699):

> Die vesper belangend soll dieselbige sommerzeit umb 3 uhr, winterzeit aber der gelegenheit nach etwas früer nach anordnung der pfarherrn geleutet und angefangen werden und in vigiliis oder primis vesperis, das ist am abent der hohen und anderer festen, sonn- und feiertagen (damit die jugent im psalliren und choralgesang, wie in allen kirchen gebreuchlich, geüebet werde) mit lateinischen psalmen, responsoriis, hymnis, Magnificat, collectis, versiculis, Benedicamus und anderm nach ordnung der psalmodiae L. Lossii [...] gesungen und gehalten werden

Touching vespers, the same shall be rung and begun in summer-time at three of the clock, but in winter-time somewhat earlier as occasion serveth, after the ordering of the parsons; and *in vigiliis* or at the first vespers, that is, on the eve of the high and other feasts, Sundays and holy days (that the youth may be exercised in psalmody and plain-song, as is used in all churches), it shall be sung and kept with Latin psalms, responds, hymns, *Magnificat*, collects, versicles, *Benedicamus* and the rest, according to the order of the *Psalmodia* of L. Lossius [...]

Burg has a sermon at vespers on the eve of the high feasts. **Burg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 427):

> Erstlich alle sonnabende und in vigiliis der hohen feste auch anderer evangelischer viertage sal in beiden pfarkirchen von dem pfarrer oder seinem diacon vesper gehalten werden [...] Und so es vor not und biqueme eracht und angesehen und

> sonderlich in den vigilien der hohen feste, so sal nach der vesper auch geprediget werden

First, on all Saturdays, and *in vigiliis* of the high feasts and also of the other evangelical holy days, vespers shall be held in both parish churches by the parson or his deacon [...] And if it be deemed needful and convenient, and in especial on the vigils of the high feasts, there shall be preaching also after vespers.

Bremen gives a list of thirteen feasts, from Sunday to Michaelmas, and then adds a rule. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 513):

> 9. Dies Pentecostes una cum adiunctis duobus 10. Dies Trinitatis 11. Dies Johannis Bapistae
> 10. Dies Visitationis Mariae 13. Dies Michaelis In horum festorum vigilia et parasceve circa horam secundam fiat vespera a tota Latina Schola in templo Beatae Virginis canendo unum atque alterum psalmum Latinum, responsorium pro tempore et hymnum Magnificat. In reliquis autem templis Germanice canatur.

9. The day of Pentecost, together with the two joined to it. 10. The day of the Trinity. 11. The day of John the Baptist. 12. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 13. The day of Michael. On the vigil and preparation of these feasts, about the second hour, let vespers be held by the whole Latin school in the church of the Blessed Virgin, singing one or two Latin psalms, the respond for the season, and the hymn *Magnificat*. But in the rest of the churches let it be sung in German.

Nicolaus Hausmann's order for Anhalt is the only order in the corpus that would like to keep the night vigil of Christmas and Easter. **Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532** (Sehling 2, p. 542):

> Vigilia paschce. natalis. Es wer auch nicht bose, das die christnacht und ostern mit der wache gehalden wurden, wie für alters.

The vigil of Easter; of the Nativity. It were also not evil that Christmas night and Easter were kept with the watch, as of old.

**Note.** Hausmann goes on to name the abuses that have grown up around the night watch. He proposes instead an early service at about three in the morning (p. 543).

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## 12.5 The Lutheran scale of feasts

### 12.5.1 The common pattern

Most orders rank the feast days in the same few steps, though the words vary.

| Rank | Names used in the orders | Usual days | How kept |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sunday | *der Sontag*, *des Herren Tag*, *dies dominica* | every Sunday | the whole day; the norm by which the feasts are measured |
| 1. The high feasts | *hohe Feste*, *Hauptfeste*, *heuptfest des herrn Christi*, *de dre groten feste Christi*, *summa festa*, *Vierzeiten*, *große Feste* | Christmas, Easter, Whitsunday, each with one or two following days; often Michaelmas as the fourth; sometimes Ascension | the whole day, usually on two or three days; two or three sermons; Latin chant, sequence and proper preface; figural music; communion; no weddings |
| 2. The other feasts of Christ and "Gospel" feasts | *die andern festa Christi*, *fürnembste Feste*, *andere herliche fest*, *gemeine fest*, *mittelmeßige festa* | Circumcision (New Year), Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Ascension, Trinity; John the Baptist, Visitation, Michaelmas; in some orders Maundy Thursday and Good Friday | usually the whole day, "as on Sundays", with the introit, sequence and preface *de tempore*; in some orders only the forenoon |
| 3. Apostles' days and other saints' days | *Aposteltage*, *kleine Feste*, *halbe Feiertage*, *festa apostolorum* | the apostles; the Conversion of Paul; often Mary Magdalene, the Beheading of John, All Saints | a sermon in the forenoon, work after it; or no holy day, with the Gospel preached on the next Sunday or at a weekday sermon |

| Rank | Names used in the orders | Usual days | How kept |
|---|---|---|---|
| 4. Abolished feasts | *papistische feste*, *abgötterische feste* | Corpus Christi, Holy Cross, the Conception, Nativity and Assumption of Mary (in most orders), All Souls, local saints | not kept; sometimes proclaimed and explained so that people know why they are gone |

The orders differ in three ways:

- **How many ranks they draw.** Some have two, many three, and a few four.
- **Where the middle feasts stand.** John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and in some orders Purification and Annunciation, sit either with the feasts of Christ or with the apostles.
- **What a lower rank means.** It may mean a half holy day, a single sermon, a transfer to Sunday, or the loss of the holy day altogether.

The families below show the main lines.

#### 12.5.2 The Saxon and Mecklenburg family: "over and above these chiefest feasts"

The line starts with the Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528. It speaks of two ranks in its own words.

**Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 164):

> Were auch gut, das sie eintrechtiglich feierten, die sontage, annunciationis, purificationis, visitationis der reinen jungfrauen Maria, S. Johannis des teufers, Michaelis, der aposteln, Magdalene, die selben feste weren denn bereit abgangen, und künten nicht bequemlich alle wider aufgericht werden. Und in sonderheit sol man halten den christag, beschneidung, epiphanie, die osterfeier, auffart, pfingsten, doch abgethan, was unchristlich legenden oder gesang darinnen gefunden werden.

It were good also that they should keep holy day with one accord on the Sundays, the Annunciation, the Purification, the Visitation of the pure Virgin Mary, St John the Baptist, Michaelmas, the apostles', Magdalene; unless those feasts be already fallen away and could not conveniently all be set up again. And in especial one shall keep Christmas, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Easter holy days, the Ascension, Whitsuntide; yet with all things done away that are found therein of unchristian legends or chants.

In Albertine Saxony the feasts of Christ follow the preamble quoted in §12.3.7. Sehling gives this part of the order in his own summary but quotes the text. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 274):

> Der tag nativitatis oder der geburt Christi sampt den andern und auch dem dritten nechstfolgenden, so man daran communicanten hat. Der tag circumcisionis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag epiphanie, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, da die weisen aus morgenland durch erscheinung des sterns zu Christo kamen. Dieser tag wird auch gehalten von der taufe Christi. Der tag der offenbarung Christi in dem tempel, so man nennet purificationis Mariae. Der tag annuntiationis seu conceptionis Christi, da Christus in der jungfrauen leib empfangen ist. Der tag coenae domini, so man nennet den grünen donnerstag, daran von dem abendmal und hochwirdigen sakrament zu predigen ist. Der tag des leidens Christi, so der karfreitag genennet wird. Der ostertag von der auferstehung des herrn sampt dem nechstfolgenden und dritten, so man communicanten hat. Der tag der himelfart Christi. Der pfingstag von der sendung des heiligen geists. Der heiligen dreifaltigkeit fest gefellet auf den nehesten sontag nach pfingsten. Hierüber sollen auch diese fest gehalten werden. Der tag S. Johannis des teufers zu ehren dem heiligen predigampt des evangelii von Christo. Der tag visitationis, da Maria ire mume Elisabeth heimgesucht hat von wegen derselben historien des evangelii. Der tag Michaelis, daran von den heiligen engeln zu predigen. […] Man mag auch die tage der heiligen aposteln halten, das man vor mittag daran predige und, so es fürfelt, die communio halte. Nachmittage aber mag man wol der teglichen arbeit warten, oder, wo man wil, mag man die evangelia und gedechtnis von den heiligen aposteln auf die nehesten sontag, so darnach gefallen, zur mittags oder vesper predigt verlegen. Desgleichen mag es auch mit etlichen anderen festen der heiligen, welcher historien im evangelio beschrieben sind, gehalten werden, als da sind S. Paulus bekerung, Marie Magalena, S. Johannis enthauptung, S. Stephan etc.

The day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and also the third next following, if there be communicants thereon. The day of the Circumcision of Christ. The day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, when the wise men from the east came to Christ by the appearing of the star; this day is also kept of the baptism of Christ. The day of the manifestation of Christ in the temple, which is called the Purification of Mary. The day of the Annunciation or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. The day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon one is to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament. The day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday. Easter day, of the resurrection of the Lord, with the next following and the third, if there be communicants. The day of the Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday, of the sending of the Holy Ghost. The feast of the holy Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. Over and above these, these feasts also shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of that history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon one is to preach of the holy angels. […] One may also keep the days of the holy apostles, so that one preach thereon before noon and, if occasion serve, hold the communion. But in the afternoon one may well attend to the daily work; or, if one will, one may put over the Gospels and remembrance of the holy apostles to the next Sunday that followeth, to the midday or evening sermon. Likewise it may be done also with certain other feasts of the saints whose histories are written in the Gospel, as are St Paul's conversion, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, St Stephen, etc.

The Merseburg synodal instruction sets the two ranks side by side, and its title for the lower rank is a phrase worth noting: "doch ahne gebotene feir", without a commanded holy day. **Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 20):

> Den ganzen tag zu feiren fur und nachmittage zu predigen: Alle sontage und volgende evangelische festa: nativitas Christi sampt dem andern auch dem dritten tage, so man daran communicanten hat […] Hiruber sollen dise feirtage gehalten werden: der tag S. Johannis des teufers zu ehren dem heiligen predigtampt des evangelii von Christo der tag visitationis, da die junkfrau Maria ihre muhme Elisabet heimgesucht hat von wegen der feinen historien des evangelii der tag Michaelis dar von den lieben engeln zu predigen. An volgenden tagen solle fur mittage predigt und communion, do es fur fiele, gehalten und die dem volk auf den sontag zuvor doch ahne gebotene feir vorkundiget werden. Als nemlich der tag cene domini, so man den grunen donnerstag nennet, daran von dem abentmahl und hochwirdigen sacrament zu predigen der tag des leidens Christi, so der karfreitag genennet wirt, dar man die ganz historia des leidens Christi dem volk furtragen solt der tag Petri und Pauli und aller apostel zu ehren des heiligen apostelampts

To keep holy day the whole day, and to preach before and after noon: all Sundays, and the following evangelical feasts: the Nativity of Christ with the second and also the third day, if there be communicants thereon […] Over and above these, these holy days shall be kept: the day of St John the Baptist, to the honour of the holy office of preaching the Gospel of Christ; the day of the Visitation, when the Virgin Mary visited her cousin Elisabeth, because of the fine history of the Gospel; the day of Michael, whereon to preach of the dear angels. On the following days preaching and communion, if it so fall out, shall be held before noon, and they shall be declared to the people on the Sunday before, yet without a commanded holy day: namely the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon to preach of the Supper and the most worthy Sacrament; the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, whereon the whole history of the Passion of Christ should be set forth to the people; the day of Peter and Paul and of all apostles, to the honour of the holy apostolic office

**Note.** Maundy Thursday and Good Friday stand in the lower rank here, beside the apostles. The feasts of Christ are placed by their standing as holy days, not by their theological weight.

The Mecklenburg order of 1552 is the fullest form of the Saxon scheme, and it is the one most often copied. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, pp. 200–201):

> Von den besondern festen oder feiertagen, so man im jar halten sol. Uber die gemeinen sontage sollen gehalten werden die hohen heubtfest des herrn Christi, als da sind. Der tag Nativitatis oder der geburt Christi, samt dem andern und dritten folgenden. Der tag Circumcisionis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag Epiphanie, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, den man nennet der heiligen drei könig tag. Der tag der opferung Christi im tempel, genant Purificationis Mariae. Der tag Annunciationis Mariae oder Conceptionis Christi, da Christus in der jungfrauen leib empfangen ist. Der tag Coenae domini, den man den grönen donnerstag nennet, daran von des herrn abendmal sol gepredigt werden. Der tag Passionis domini oder des leidens und sterbens Christi, welcher der karfreitag genennet wird. Der ostertag oder Pasca, der tag der ufferstehung Christi, samt dem folgenden montag und dienstag. Der tag Ascensionis oder himelfart Christi. Der pfingstag, samt dem folgenden montag und dienstag. Der tag Trinitatis gefelt uff den nehesten sontag nach pfingsten. Uff diese fest sol es mit ordnung der lection, gesange, predigten und communio gehalten werden, wie den gemeinen sontagen, allein, das die introitus, sequenz und prefationes de tempore gesungen

> werden. […] Uber diese furnemsten fest sollen auch die gehalten werden. Die tage der aposteln. Der tag S. Johannis des teufers. Der tag Visitationis, da Maria ire mume Elisabeth heimsucht. […] Der tag Michaelis, an welchem die lere von den heiligen engeln dem volk sol furgetragen werden. An diesen tagen sol man vor mittage predigen, und so communicanten da sind, die communion halten, wie an den sontagen. Nach mittage aber mag man wol der gewönlichen erbeit warten. Ausgenomen den tag Michaelis, an welchem vor und nach mittage sol gepredigt werden. Das fest aber Assumptionis, oder himelfart Marie, sol hinfurder ganz abgethan sein, und an des selben stat das fest S. Michaelis als ein viergezeiten fest gehalten werden.

Of the special feasts or holy days which shall be kept in the year. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept the high chief feasts of the Lord Christ, which are these: the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second and third following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ, when Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb; the day of the Lord's Supper, which is called Maundy Thursday, whereon shall be preached of the Lord's Supper; the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, which is called Good Friday; Easter day, or Pascha, the day of the resurrection of Christ, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday, with the Monday and Tuesday following; the day of the Trinity falleth on the next Sunday after Pentecost. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and prefaces *de tempore* be sung. […] Over and above these chiefest feasts these also shall be kept: the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation, when Mary visiteth her cousin Elisabeth; […] the day of Michael, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. On these days one shall preach before noon, and if there be communicants, hold the communion, as on Sundays; but in the afternoon one may well attend to the wonted work. Except the day of Michael, whereon there shall be preaching before and after noon. But the feast of the Assumption, or Ascension of Mary, shall henceforth be wholly done away, and in the stead of the same the feast of St Michael be kept as a feast of the four times.

**Note.** Michaelmas has a place of its own in this scheme:

- It is listed with the second rank, but it is preached "before and after noon" like a feast of Christ.
- It takes the Assumption's place as one of the four *Vierzeiten* (§12.9).

The Mecklenburg text, with small changes, stands in these orders:

| Order | Sehling | Changes of note |
|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 | 18, pp. 205–206 | apostles' days not named one by one (listed in the *Feiertagsordnung* of 1561, §12.6.2) |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, pp. 550–551 | follows Mecklenburg closely, including the prefaces *de tempore* |
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 151–152 | "Aber an solchen apostelntagen nach der predigt mag ein jeder seiner arbeit woll warten"; Corpus Christi explicitly abolished |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097 | Michaelmas "anstadt des fests assumtionis oder himelfart Mariae als ein viergezeitenfest"; Te Deum for the harvest |
| Lüneburg (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 6/1, pp. 660–661 | as Lüneburg 1564 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 391–392 | prefaces *de tempore* only "auff den Viergezeiten Festagen" (§12.9) |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, p. 166 | Trinity "hochfeyerlich" |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9, pp. 272–273 | Michaelmas "fur das virte heuptfest"; Good Friday "halb feierlich biß auff den mittag" (§12.6.1) |

| Order | Sehling | Changes of note |
|---|---|---|
| Kronstadt (Transylvania), *Agende*, 1547 | 24, p. 255 | the list itself follows the Nürnberg model (§12.5.7, §12.8.3); the closing admonition is taken from the Saxon order of 1539/40 |

### 12.5.3 The Württemberg family: holy days proclaimed by the magistrate

The Württemberg orders make the magistrate's proclamation the mark of a holy day (§12.3.5). At first they drew only one clear line: the high feasts of Christ kept the whole day, and the rest kept only in the forenoon.

**Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, pp. 105–106):

> Es sollen aber in unserm Fürstenthumb nachvolgende fest- und feyrtag gehalten werden: Erstlich alle Sontag, Item, alle hohe fest Christi als namlich Weyhennächt, Beschneidung, Ostertag, Auffarttag, Pfingstag. Und sollen dise tag doch auch ungefar gehalten und niemand sein gewissen damit beschwert werden [...] Weiter aber sollen all pfarrer auff nachverzeichnet tag morgens predigen und als dann dem volck anzeigen, das sich nachmittag meniglich an sein arbeit verfügen möge unnd hierinn niemandt verstrickt sein sol. Namlich auff der heiligen drey künig oder den zwölfften tag, da soll man predigen aus dem Mattheo das ander Capitel, den grünen donnerstag, den karfreitag, so man den passion prediget, unser frawen verkündung tag Annuntiationis, unnser frawen Reynigung Purificationis, aller apostel tag, Sant Johannis des täuffers tag.

But in our principality the feasts and holy days following shall be kept: first all Sundays; item, all the high feasts of Christ, namely Christmas, the Circumcision, Easter day, Ascension day, Whitsunday. And these days also shall be kept without constraint, and no man's conscience burdened therewith [...] But further, all parsons shall preach in the morning on the days hereafter noted, and then shew the people that every man may betake himself to his work in the afternoon, and that herein no man shall be bound: namely on the day of the Three Kings or Twelfth Day, whereon shall be preached out of Matthew the second chapter; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday, when the Passion is preached; our Lady's Annunciation day; our Lady's Purification; all apostles' days; St John the Baptist's day.

The Württemberg list follows the preamble of §12.3.5. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

> Alle Sontag Der Christag Der nächst tag darnach Der Jars tag Der öberst, Epiphania genannt Der Ostertag sampt dem nächsten darnach Die himelfart Christi Der Pfingstag sampt volgendem Montag Die Liechtmeß Purificationis Mariae Verkündigung Mariae, genannt Annunciationis Aller Aposteln tag Joannis Baptisten

All Sundays. Christmas day. The next day after. New Year's day. Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany. Easter day with the next after. The Ascension of Christ. Whitsunday with the Monday following. Candlemas, the Purification of Mary. The Annunciation of Mary. All apostles' days. John the Baptist's.

**Note.** In 1553 every day on the list is a holy day, with no half days. The distinction came back in later orders of the family:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561** added half days (§12.6.2).
- **Pfalz-Veldenz 1574** added half days as well (§12.6.2).
- **Baden 1603** has the same list but allows field-work after the morning service:

**Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1603** (Sehling 16, p. 559):

> Die Sontag seyndt aller dings stricte zufeyren undt alle Feldt- und andere arbeit einzustellen, zugleich auch die ordentliche Fest- und Aposteltag vormittag simpliciter gefeyret, nachmittag allein mit der discretion zur Feldtarbeit zugelaßen werden soll

The Sundays are to be kept holy altogether strictly, and all field-work and other labour to cease; likewise the ordinary feast days and apostles' days shall be kept holy in the forenoon without condition, and in the afternoon field-work shall be allowed only with discretion

### 12.5.4 The Bugenhagen family: "the three great feasts of Christ"

Bugenhagen's orders count feasts from the three great feasts of Christ. Each is kept three full days. The rest are "full" holy days for their Gospel histories. The apostles are commemorated on the next Sunday.

**Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 397):

> De dre groten feste Christi, de de Christene stedes hebben geholden, alse Winachten, Paschen unde Pynxten, eyn jewelick fest dre dage vullen to vyren, darinne geprediget schal werden up den morgen, vor middage, na middage unde up den avent, darto gesungen, alse na gesecht schal werden. Darto nyejarsdach, Epiphanie, dat is der apenbaringe edder koningedach, purificationis, dat is Marien kerckgank, Marien vorkundinge, des Heren hemmelvart, Joannis Baptiste, Marien berchgank vullen to vyren, nicht umme der dage willen, sonder umme des predigens willen, dewile de historien in den evangelien begrepen synt unde bedrapen unsen Heren Christum etc. Item Michaelis vor eyn vehrtidenvest, to offeren dat vehrtidenoffer in de gemeyne schatkaste, ock vullen to vyren. […] Der hilgen apostelen unde Magdalene unde Laurentii, des hilgen kastenheren edder diakens, gedechtnissen scholen gelecht werden up den negesten Sundach na öreme kalenderdage, also dat me vlitich predigen schal dat evangelium vamme Sundage alse up eynen anderen Sundach unde deme jo nichts affbreken; alle sank unde misse schal ock syn vamme Sundage, alleyne amme ende des sermons schal de predicante seggen: Myne frunde in Christo, in disser weke plecht me gedenken des hilgen apostels N., van deme lest me so in evangelio, in Actis apo. etc.

The three great feasts of Christ which the Christians have always kept, as Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, every feast to be fully kept holy three days, wherein there shall be preaching in the morning, before noon, after noon and at evening, and singing thereto, as shall be said hereafter. Thereto New Year's day, the Epiphany, that is the day of the manifestation or the Kings' day, the Purification, that is Mary's church-going, Mary's Annunciation, the Lord's Ascension, John the Baptist, Mary's going over the hills, to be fully kept holy; not for the days' sake, but for the preaching's sake, forasmuch as the histories are contained in the Gospels and concern our Lord Christ, etc. Item, Michaelmas for a feast of the four times, to offer the four-times offering into the common treasure-chest, also to be fully kept holy. […] The memorials of the holy apostles, and of Magdalene, and of Laurence the holy chest-master or deacon, shall be laid upon the next Sunday after their calendar day; so that one shall diligently preach the Gospel of the Sunday as upon another Sunday, and take nothing at all from it; all chant and mass also shall be of the Sunday; only at the end of the sermon the preacher shall say: My friends in Christ, in this week it is wont to be remembered of the holy apostle N., of whom one readeth thus in the Gospel, in the Acts of the apostles, etc.

**Note.**

- **Why the apostles lost their holy day.** The editor records that Bugenhagen first meant to keep the apostles' days as feasts. He gave up the plan when it was objected that a town of craftsmen would then have too many holy days.
- **Hamburg 1529.** Hamburg has the same text (Sehling 5, p. 514).
- **Lübeck 1531.** Lübeck adds the list of the four times (§12.9).

**Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 4, p. 343):

> Unde de historien van unserm leven heren Jesu Christo nicht vorgeten werden, wille wi de festa Christi alle beholden, als winachten dree dage, osteren dree dage, pinxsten dree dage, dar negest Circuncisionis, Epiphanie, Purificationis, Annunciationis, Ascensionis, Trinitatis, Johannis Baptiste to predekende, van siner entfanginge, van siner gebort, van sinem predekende unde amt, unde van siner enthovedinge, dat fest hört ock up Christum, unde de historie is ock in den evangelien geschreven. Visitationis des geliken. Item wi willen ock beholden dat fest Michaelis to predikende van den engeln ut der hiligen schrift.

And that the histories of our dear Lord Jesus Christ be not forgotten, we will keep all the feasts of Christ: as Christmas three days, Easter three days, Whitsuntide three days; next thereafter the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Ascension, the Trinity; John the Baptist, to preach of his conception, of his birth, of his preaching and office, and of his beheading, for that feast also pertaineth to Christ, and the history is also written in the Gospels. The Visitation likewise. Item, we will also keep the feast of Michael, to preach of the angels out of holy Scripture.

The Schleswig-Holstein list follows the principle quoted in §12.3.3. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

> De dre groten Feste Christi vyren wy ein ytlick dre dage lanck umme der Historien Christi willen. Darbeneven vyren wy ock dat Fest Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Purificationis unde Annunctiationis Marie. […] Ock vyre wy de Festa Ascensionis

> und Visitationis […] Thom lesten dat fest Johannis Baptiste, Dat fest Michaelis thor danckseggínge Unde dat fest Omnium Sanctorum. Der Apostel Feste schal men apentlick affkündigen und thogelick dem feste Magdalene unde Laurentii am negst volgenden Sondage darna Predigen.

The three great feasts of Christ we keep holy each three days long, for the histories of Christ. Beside these we keep holy also the feast of the Circumcision, of the Epiphany, of the Purification and of the Annunciation of Mary. […] We keep holy also the feasts of the Ascension and of the Visitation […] Last of all the feast of John the Baptist, the feast of Michael for thanksgiving, and the feast of All Saints. The apostles' feasts one shall openly proclaim, and preach them, together with the feast of Magdalene and of Laurence, on the next following Sunday thereafter.

**Note.** The editor explains the "Festa Ascensionis" as the Assumption of Mary, on 15 August. The Danish-Holstein order of 1542 is thus one of the few Lutheran orders that keeps the Assumption as a holy day (§12.8.3). The Kiel draft behind it follows the Danish *Ordinatio ecclesiastica* of 1537.

### 12.5.5 Numbered classes

Some orders number their ranks outright.

Grubenhagen names three classes, and gives each its reason. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1032–1033):

> VI. Von den feyertagen, welche man feyeren soll. Festum nativitatis Christi, S. Stephanstagk, des ersten merterers, S. Johannistagk, des evangelisten, der unschuldigen kinderlein tagk, weil die predigt wart, festum resurrectionis Christi, den Mondagk und auch den Dinstagk, festum Pentecostae, Pfingsten, den Mondagk und auch den Dinstagk zu feyeren, festum Michaelis archangeli. Das sind also die vier hauptfest, an welchen man den vierzeitpenning sammelt. Nun folgen andere herliche fest, die man auch feyren soll: Festum circumcisionis Domini, f. epiphaniae vel trium regum, f. purificationis Mariae, f. anuntiacionis Mariae, f. visitationis Mariae, f. ascensionis Jesu Christi, f. S. Johannis Baptistae. Das sind also andere sieben festage, die auch zum hochsten von wegen der historien zu feyren nottig. 1. S. Andres tagk, 2. S. Thomas tagk, 3. S. Matthias tagk, 4. den grünen Donnerstagk, 5. den stillen Freytagk, 6. S. Philippi et Jacobi tagk, 7. S. Petri et Pauli tagk, 8. S. […] Jacobs tagk, 9. S. Bartholomei tagk, 10. S. Matthäi apostoli tagk, 11. S. Simonis et Judä tagk. Diese tage der lieben heiligen und jünger unsers Hern Jesu Christi soll man vormittage alleine, weil das ampt wart, schuldig sein zu feyren.

VI. Of the holy days which shall be kept. The feast of the Nativity of Christ; St Stephen's day, of the first martyr; St John's day, of the evangelist; the day of the innocent children, while the sermon lasteth; the feast of the resurrection of Christ, the Monday and also the Tuesday; the feast of Pentecost, Whitsuntide, the Monday and also the Tuesday to be kept holy; the feast of Michael the archangel. These are therefore the four chief feasts, whereon the four-times penny is gathered. Now follow other glorious feasts, which shall also be kept holy: the feast of the Circumcision of the Lord; the feast of the Epiphany or of the Three Kings; the feast of the Purification of Mary; the feast of the Annunciation of Mary; the feast of the Visitation of Mary; the feast of the Ascension of Jesus Christ; the feast of St John the Baptist. These are therefore seven other feast days, which also are in the highest degree needful to be kept holy because of the histories. 1. St Andrew's day, 2. St Thomas's day, 3. St Matthias's day, 4. Maundy Thursday, 5. Good Friday, 6. St Philip and James's day, 7. St Peter and Paul's day, 8. St […] James's day, 9. St Bartholomew's day, 10. St Matthew the apostle's day, 11. St Simon and Jude's day. These days of the dear saints and disciples of our Lord Jesus Christ one shall be bound to keep holy in the forenoon only, while the office lasteth.

**Note.** The first class is defined partly by a church payment. The four chief feasts are the days on which the four-times penny is collected (§12.9). The Ascension stands in the second class, and Maundy Thursday and Good Friday in the third. The editor notes that this departs from the Wolfenbüttel order of 1543, which moved the apostles' days to the next Sunday.

**Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 474):

> [5.] Welche fest in unserer kirchen gefeiert werden. Uber die gemeinen sontäge werden mit verstand christlicher freiheit gehalten: Erstlich alle festa Christi: Nativitatis mit den volgenden zweien tagen, Circumcisionis, Epiphaniae, Purificationis, Annunciationis, Ostertag samt den zweien nachvolgenden tagen, Ascensionis, Pfingstag sampt den volgenden zweien tagen. Zum andern werden gehalten alle aposteltage. Zum dritten: Johannis baptistae, Michaelis archangeli.

[5.] Which feasts are kept holy in our church. Over and above the common Sundays are kept, with understanding of Christian liberty: first, all the feasts of Christ: the Nativity with the two days following, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, Easter day with the two days next following, the Ascension, Whitsunday with the two days following. Secondly are kept all the apostles' days. Thirdly: John the Baptist, Michael the archangel.

**Note.** Regensburg's numbering is an order of listing, not of dignity. Communion and first vespers, which mark the rank in this order, are given only "an festen Christi, allen und jeden", on each and every feast of Christ (p. 475; see §12.10.9).

Hoya has four ranks, the fourth being the abolished Assumption. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1186):

> Die vier hohen fest belangende, ordnen wir, das Weynachten, Ostern, Pfingsten mit den zweyen folgenden tagen sollen geruhet, gefeyert und mit übung göttliches worts zugebracht werden. Dieweil aber das fest der himelfart Mariae ohne grund und gezeugnis der schrift durch den antichrist eingefüret ist, sol es in unser graffschaft hiemit ganz abgethan sein und seiner hinfüro nicht gedacht werden. Wir ordnen aber anstadt desselben das fest S. Michaelis und wollen, das die pfarrkinder den tag feyerlich halten, auch ihrem pastorn an demselben tage ihr opfer und gebürliche pflicht gütlich entrichten und ohne hindernis dargeben sollen. Zum andern ordnen wir, das nachgeschriebene und verzeichnete fest und tage in unser herrschaft genzlich geruhet, gefeyret und geheiliget werden sollen, als des neuen jhars tag, der heiligen drey könig tag, das festum purificationis Mariae, verkündigung Mariae, der himelfart Christi, Johannis des teufers tag, visitationis Mariae, der tag coenae Domini, an welchem man vom h. nachtmal predigen sol, den Kahrfreytag [...] Zum dritten ordnen wir, das man nachgesetzte apostel- und heiligentage, biß die serrnon geendet, feyren sol: als Andreae Thomae bekerung Pauli Matthiae Petri et Pauli Philippi et Jacobi Magdalenen Jacobi Bartholomaei decollationis Johannis Matthaei Simonis et Judae aller heiligen tag.

As touching the four high feasts, we ordain that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy, and spent in the exercise of God's Word. But forasmuch as the feast of the Ascension of Mary was brought in by the Antichrist without ground and witness of Scripture, it shall hereby be wholly done away in our county, and no more be mentioned henceforth. But in the stead thereof we ordain the feast of St Michael, and will that the parishioners keep the day solemnly, and also render to their pastor on the same day their offering and due duty kindly and without hindrance. Secondly we ordain that the feasts and days hereafter written and set down shall in our lordship be wholly rested, kept holy and hallowed: as New Year's day, the day of the Three Kings, the feast of the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, the Ascension of Christ, John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary, the day of the Lord's Supper, whereon one shall preach of the holy Supper, Good Friday [...] Thirdly we ordain that the apostles' and saints' days hereafter set shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended: as Andrew, Thomas, the Conversion of Paul, Matthias, Peter and Paul, Philip and James, Magdalene, James, Bartholomew, the Beheading of John, Matthew, Simon and Jude, All Saints' day.

The Harlingerland order repeats Hoya's text, divided into titled *Sectiones*. **Harlingerland (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 735–736):

> Der eilfte articull. Von den festen. Sectio prima. Von den vier zeiten. Die vier hohen festtage belangende, ordnen wir auch, daß Wihnachten, Paschen, Pfingsten mit den zween folgenden tagen sollen gerouwet, gefyret und mit öving deß gottlichen wordeß geheiliget werden. Von der himmelfahrt Mariae. Dieweile daß fest ohne grund und gezeugniß der schrift durch dem antechrist ist angerichtet, soll idt ganz abgetaen sein und seiner nit gedacht werden. Ordnen derohalben, daß der [!] letzste und vierte hochfesttagzeit solle S. Michaelis tag sein. [...] Sectio secunda. Von den fürnembsten festtagen. [...] Sectio tertia. Von den aposteltagen. Ordnen wir, daß man undergeschrieben aposteltage, beht der sermön geendiget, fihren solle

The eleventh article. Of the feasts. Section the first. Of the four times. As touching the four high feast days, we ordain also that Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, with the two days following, shall be rested, kept holy and hallowed with the exercise of the divine Word. Of the Ascension of Mary. Forasmuch as that feast was set up by the Antichrist without ground and witness of the Scripture, it shall be wholly done away and not be mentioned. We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. [...] Section the second. Of the chiefest feast days. [...] Section the third. Of the apostles' days. We ordain that the apostles' days underwritten shall be kept holy until the sermon be ended

Sayn has four classes, set out as a principle before the list. The margin heads the paragraph *Festa quadrupli*. **Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 19/1, p. 368):

> Unndt konden die festen durch gantze jahr in viererley artt oder underschiedliche hauffe getheilt werden: 1. Etzliche festa, das seind haubtfesta also zu nennen, die man solenniter den gantzen tag feieren unndt darauff die gemeine wochentliche arbeit soll underlaßen werden. 2. Die ander seind nur mittelmeßige festa, die da halb gefeiret werden also unndt der gestalt, das man vormittag zur kirchen komme, predigt haltte unnd hör, nach mittag aber in wochentlicher abeit vortfahre. 3. Die dritte festag könnenn ohn nachteil unndt ergernus verlegt unndt auffgehoben werden auf den gemeinen bettag, so sonst in der wochen zur predigt deputirt unndt geordenet ist. 4. Die viertten festtage, so zu bestettigung offentlicher abgotterei im bapstumb eingefuhrt unndt gehalten worden, sollen in unserm evangelischen kirchen gar abgeschafft unndt underlaßen werden.

And the feasts through the whole year might be divided into four kinds or several companies:

1. Some feasts are to be called chief feasts, which men shall keep holy solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. 2. The others are but middling feasts, which are kept half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church in the forenoon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. 3. The third feast days may without hurt and offence be removed and taken up upon the common day of prayer, which otherwise is deputed and ordained in the week for preaching. 4. The fourth feast days, which were brought in and kept in the papacy for the confirming of open idolatry, shall in our evangelical churches be wholly done away and left off.

The list attached to it. **Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 19/1, pp. 372–373):

> Hauptvesta, so den gantzen tagh feierlich gehalten undt daruff die gemeine wochentliche arbeit soll underlassen werdenn. Der heilige christagh. S. Stephani tagh. S. Joannis tag vormittagh. Der neue jars tag vor- und nachmittagh. Epiphania Domini oder der heiligen drey konig tag. Purificationis Mariae oder liechtmeß. Annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis christi, welches fest, so es in der marterwoch oder nach ostern gefelt, sol es auf den sonabend palmarum stets gelegt werden. Der ostertag sampt den zweien nachvolgenden, montag und dienstagh. Der himelfartstag Christi durch auß. Der pfingstag und beide volgende, montag und dinstag in pfingsten. Das fest der heiligen dreyfaltigkeit, so allwege acht tage nach pfingsten volget. […] Der tag Johannis des täuffers. S. Michaels tag, dar man pfleget von den h. engeln zu predigen und gott fur den guten schutz der guten geister zu dancken. Nachvolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiret also und der gestalt, das man vor mittage zur kirchen komme, predigt halte und hore, nach mittag aber in wochentlicher arbeit fortfahre. Alle apostel tage sollen gehalten werden, wen undt wie sie des jars fallen, doch allein mit einer predigt vormittag halb feierlich. Der aposteln tage sollen gleich geachtet und fur halbe feiertag gerechnet werden: Der grüne donnerstag […] Der charfreitag […] Pauli bekehrungstag umb der furtreflichen historien willen. Mariae visitationis oder heimsuchungfest. Diese volgende und dergleichen tage mogen auf denn verordenten bettagen in der wochen geleget werden, als: S. Laurentii tagh. S. Marci, des evangelisten. S. Lucas, des evangelisten. […] Vincula Petri. Decollationis Joannis Baptistae. […] Aller heyligen, omnium sanctorum. Mariae Magdalenen fest umb der schonen text und historien willen, so daruf zue handlen verordnet, damit [sie] in gedechtnus bleiben. Unten verzeichnete tag sollen gar abgeschaft und underlaßen werden, als die da zur abgotterey und aberglauben anleitung und vorschub geben. Alle Marienfest, sie haben nahmen wie sie wollen, welche hiebevor nicht benennet worden. Sonderlich aber festum conceptionis, nativitatis, praesentationis, assumptionis Mariae sollen in unsern evangelischen kürchen gar auffgehoben und abe sein

Chief feasts, which shall be kept solemnly the whole day, and whereon the common weekly work shall be left off. The holy Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John's day in the forenoon. New Year's day, before and after noon. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the day of the Three Kings. The Purification of Mary, or Candlemas. The Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ; which feast, if it fall in the week of the Passion or after Easter, shall always be laid on the Saturday before Palm Sunday. Easter day with the two following, Monday and Tuesday. The day of the Ascension of Christ, throughout. Whitsunday and both the following, Monday and Tuesday in Whitsuntide. The feast of the holy Trinity, which followeth always eight days after Pentecost. […] The day of John the Baptist. St Michael's day, whereon men are wont to preach of the holy angels and to thank God for the good protection of the good spirits. The days following are kept but half holy, in this wise and manner, that men come to church before noon, hold and hear a sermon, but in the afternoon go on in the weekly work. All apostles' days shall be kept, when and as they fall in the year, yet only with one sermon in the forenoon, half holy. With the apostles' days shall be counted alike, and reckoned for half holy days: Maundy Thursday […] Good Friday […] St Paul's conversion day, for the excellent history's sake. The feast of Mary's Visitation. These days following, and the like, may be laid on the appointed days of prayer in the week: as St Laurence's day; St Mark the evangelist's; St Luke the evangelist's; […] Peter's Chains; the Beheading of John the Baptist; […] All Saints; Mary Magdalene's feast, for the sake of the fair text and history appointed to be handled thereon, that [they] may remain

in remembrance. The days noted beneath shall be wholly done away and left off, as those that give occasion and furtherance to idolatry and superstition: all feasts of Mary, be their names what they will, which have not been named heretofore; but in especial the feasts of the Conception, Nativity, Presentation and Assumption of Mary shall in our evangelical churches be wholly taken up and be gone

**Note.** This is the fullest four-rank system in the corpus. The Sayn *Kirchenordnung* of 1590 (Sehling 19/1, p. 389) later reduced it to a single list of holy days, with the harvest apostles kept in the forenoon only (§12.6.4).

The Aschersleben town agenda has a middle rank of eight feasts over and above the three chief feasts. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 479):

> Uber die drei heubtfeste, sollen auch in dieser christlichen gemeinde diese nachfolgende gehalten werden. 1. Circumcisionis domini. 2. Epiphanias domini. 3. Purificationis Mariae. 4. Annunciationis Mariae. 5. Ascensionis domini. 6. Johannis baptistae. 7. Visitationis Mariae, 8. Michaelis. In diesen festen soll es durchaus, wie an sontagen gehalten werden, allein das mit singen und predigen auf die fest gesehen und figurirt werde. […] Von den festis apostolorum. Andreae, Thomae, Matthiae, Philippi Jacobi, Petri et Pauli, Jacobi, Bartholomaei, Matthaei, Simonis et Judae: Sollen in unser gemeine fruehe eine predigt und das officium gehalten werden vormittage alleine. Die arbeitsleute aber mögen ein jeder seiner hantierung warten

Over and above the three chief feasts, these following shall also be kept in this Christian congregation: 1. The Circumcision of the Lord. 2. The Epiphany of the Lord. 3. The Purification of Mary. 4. The Annunciation of Mary. 5. The Ascension of the Lord. 6. John the Baptist. 7. The Visitation of Mary. 8. Michael. On these feasts it shall be done throughout as on Sundays; only that in singing and preaching regard be had to the feast, and that figural music be used. […] Of the feasts of the apostles. Andrew, Thomas, Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, James, Bartholomew, Matthew, Simon and Jude: in our congregation there shall be held early a sermon and the office, before noon only. But the working people may each attend to his handiwork

### 12.5.6 Great feasts and small feasts: Danzig and Thorn

In Danzig the rank of a feast was marked above all by the bells (§12.10.7). The church fathers of St Mary's set down the custom in 1612. Article 16 lists every feast of the year as *ein gross fest* or *ein klein fest*.

**Danzig, St Mary's, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612** (Sehling 4, pp. 203–204):

> Art. 14. Vom beigern auf die grossen feste. Wan ein gross fest einfellet, welches allezeit mit drei predigten gehalten wird, alsdan wird des tages zuvor vormittage geleutet, wie sonst auf den tag in der woche gebreuchlich. […] Art. 15. Wie man auf die kleinen feste beigert. Auf die kleinen feste, welche allzeit nur mit einer predigt gehalten werden, es sei dan, das etwa eines auf einen sontag einfeilet, oder vom sontage dahin verlegt wird, alsdann wird des tages zuvor nach mittage, wen es eins geschlagen hat, mit der Dominical und Apostolica gebeigert und mit der Osanna darein geleutet und dis heisset man mit der Osanna beiern […] Art. 16. Namen der grossen und kleinen feste, nach dem lauf des jahres, an welchem man beigert.

Art. 14. Of chiming for the great feasts. When a great feast falleth, which is always kept with three sermons, then on the day before it is rung in the forenoon as is otherwise used on a day in the week. […] Art. 15. How one chimeth for the small feasts. For the small feasts, which are always kept with one sermon only, unless one of them fall on a Sunday, or be removed thither from the Sunday, then on the day before, in the afternoon, when it hath struck one, it is chimed with the Dominical and the Apostolica, and rung in with the Osanna; and this is called chiming with the Osanna […] Art. 16. The names of the great and small feasts, according to the course of the year, whereon one chimeth.

**The Danzig list of 1612** (Art. 16, p. 204). It is condensed here from the two-column print. The first entry, a small feast before Epiphany, has lost its name in the digitized text.

| **Great feasts (*ein gross fest*)** | **Small feasts (*ein klein fest*)** |
|---|---|
| Epiphany; Purification; Annunciation; Easter day, Easter Monday, Easter Tuesday ("mit einer predigt"); Ascension; Whitsunday, Whit Monday, Whit Tuesday ("mit einer predigt"); Trinity; Visitation ("mit predigt"); Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist ("mit 1 predigt") | Matthias; Philip and James; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; James; Bartholomew; Matthew; Michaelmas ("mit 3 predigten … ein klein fest"); Simon and Jude; Andrew; Thomas |

Two entries on the list are "no feast". The Dominicans' day (5 August) and St Laurence's day are rung with the great bell to open and close the town's market, and the list says of Laurence: "ist kein fest".

Thorn sets the same two ranks in prose, and also speaks of the "small or half feasts". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 239):

> Alle feste unsers herrn und erlösers, als nemlich nativitatis Christi, circumcisionis, epiphaniae, purificationis, annunciationis, coenae dominicae, parasceves, paschae, ascensionis et pentecostes sollen so wohl ordentlich als ehrlich und mit grossem ernst, gebührlicher reverenz zum gedächtniss und vermahnung gehalten werden, sonderlich weinachten, ostern und pfingsten drei tage nacheinander: die ersten zwei tage mit dreien predigten wie sonsten am sonntage; am dritten tage, wo er nicht auf einen sonntage gefällt, mit zween predigten [...] Belangende aber die feste oder feiertagen conversionis Pauli, Johannis Baptistae, visitationis Mariae, Michaelis, samt den zwölf aposteltagen, sollen mit zwei predigten gehalten werden [...] wann aber solche kleine oder halbe feste auf einen sonntag kommen, mögen dieselben wohl auf den folgenden tag, nemlich auf den sonntag, verleget und zur vesper gehalten werden.

All the feasts of our Lord and Redeemer, namely the Nativity of Christ, the Circumcision, the Epiphany, the Purification, the Annunciation, the Supper of the Lord, the Preparation, Easter, the Ascension and Pentecost, shall be kept as well orderly as honourably, and with great earnestness and due reverence, for remembrance and admonition; in especial Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide three days one after another: the first two days with three sermons, as otherwise on the Sunday; on the third day, where it fall not on a Sunday, with two sermons [...] But touching the feasts or holy days of the Conversion of Paul, of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, of Michael, together with the twelve apostles' days, they shall be kept with two sermons [...] but when such small or half feasts come upon a Sunday, the same may well be removed to the following day, namely to the Sunday [afternoon], and be kept at vespers.

**Note.** The sentence "auf den folgenden tag, nemlich auf den sonntag" is confused in the print. The meaning, as the next sentence shows, is that a small feast falling near a Sunday is handled at the Sunday vespers. Compare §12.14.

#### 12.5.7 Wider calendars: the conservative orders

A number of orders keep much more than the pattern of §12.5.1. Some are early, and some come from princes who were cautious about change. They show where the Lutheran lists started from.

**Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 87):

> Folgen die festa, so furnemlich in unsern landen, ausserhalb der sontage, gehalten und gefeiert werden sollen. Nemlich: Der Christtag. Der tag Stefani. Der tag Johannis Evangeliste. Des neuen jarstag oder Circumcisionis domini. Der heiligen dreier könig tag. Der tag Purificationis Marie. Der tag Matthie Apostoli. Der tag Annunciationis Marie. Der Ostertag. Ostermontag. Der tag Philippi et Jacobi. Ascensionis domini oder himelfart Christi. Der Pfingsttag. Montag. Dinstag. Der sontag Trinitatis. Der tag Corporis Christi. Der tag Johannis Baptiste. Der tag Petri und Pauli. Der tag Visitationis Marie. Der tag Marie Magdalene. Der tag Jacobi. Der tag Assumptionis Marie. Der tag Bartholomei. Der tag Nativitatis Marie. Der tag Matthei Apostoli. Der tag Simonis et Jude. Der tag Omnium Sanctorum. Der tag Martini. Der tag Andree. Der tag Laurentii. Der tag' Michaelis.

There follow the feasts which, besides the Sundays, shall chiefly be kept and held holy in our lands. Namely: Christmas day. St Stephen's day. St John the Evangelist's day. New Year's day, or the Circumcision of the Lord. The day of the Three Kings. The day of the Purification of Mary. The day of Matthias the apostle. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. Easter day. Easter Monday. The day of Philip and James. The Ascension of the Lord. Whitsunday. Monday. Tuesday. Trinity Sunday. The day of Corpus Christi. The day of John the Baptist. The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of Mary Magdalene. The day of James. The day of the Assumption of Mary. The day of Bartholomew. The day of the Nativity of Mary. The day of Matthew the apostle. The day of Simon and Jude. All Saints' day. St Martin's day. St Andrew's day. St Laurence's day. St Michael's day.

**Note.** The list goes on with Catherine and Thomas. It is a single rank that keeps Corpus Christi, the Assumption, the Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence and Catherine. It matches the conservative character of the Brandenburg order as a whole.

Hausmann's Anhalt order has an early, one-rank list with the apostles already reduced to the forenoon. **Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532** (Sehling 2, p. 542):

> Festa im jar sollen frei gehalden werden, zum exempel des glaubens zu uben, damit das junge und grobe volk gemussiget mügen zur prediget kommen […] und sint mit namen dise: Nativitas Christi mit zweien tagen. Neu jar, circumcisionis. Epiphanie, wilchs heist drei König. Purificationis Christi et Marie. Annunciacionis Christi. Pascha mit zweien tagen, ostern. Ascensionis, himmelfart Christi. Pentecostes, pfingsten mit zwei tagen. Corporis Christi, des heiligen warlichnames tag. Johannis baptiste. Visitacionis, conceptionis Marie. Magdalene. Marie. Laurencii. Assumpcionis Nativitatis Michaelis. Omnium sanctorum. Martini. Aller apostel tage fur mittage.

The feasts in the year shall be kept free, for the exercise of faith, that the young and rude people may be at leisure to come to the sermon […] and they are these by name: the Nativity of Christ with two days; New Year, the Circumcision; the Epiphany, which is called Three Kings; the Purification of Christ and of Mary; the Annunciation of Christ; Pascha with two days, Easter; the Ascension, the ascending of Christ; Pentecost, Whitsuntide with two days; Corpus Christi, the day of the holy true Body; John the Baptist; the Visitation, the Conception of Mary; Magdalene; Mary; Laurence; the Assumption; the Nativity; Michael; All Saints; Martin; all apostles' days in the forenoon.

The editor places the Pfalz-Neuburg list between Brandenburg 1540 and Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 94):

> so wöllen wir, das dise nachfolgende fest und feirtag, wie vor alters her, noch gehalten und gefeiret werden - doch, damit die andern tag der gedechtnus Christi und der rechten, waren heiligen, so in der heiligen schrift oder sonst irs christlichen glaubens, lebens, wunderwerk, leidens und seligen absterbens gewise zeugnus haben, nicht aufgehebt noch in vergessen gestellt, sonder ungefeiret in gedechtnus, wie vor alters her, lassen bleiben. Die fest, so man feiern sol. Der Neujarstag, Circumcisionis genannt, der Oberstag, Epiphaniae genannt, Lichtmeß, Purificationis Mariae genannt, Matthie des zwölf boten, Verkündung, Annunciationis Mariae genannt, der Palmtag, der Ostertag mit montag und aftermontag darnach, Philippi und Jacobi der zwölf boten, der Auffartstag, Ascensionis Domini genannt, der Pfingstag mit montag und aftermontag darnach, der Heiligen Dreifeltigkeit, Trinitatis genannt, Johannis des taufers, Petri und Pauli der zwölf boten, Jacobi des zwölf boten, Unser Frauen schidung, Assumptionis genannt

so will we that these following feasts and holy days be yet kept and held holy, as of old; yet so that the other days of the remembrance of Christ, and of the right and true saints who have sure witness in holy Scripture or otherwise of their Christian faith, life, miracles, suffering and blessed departing, be not taken away nor put in forgetfulness, but let remain unhallowed in remembrance, as of old. The feasts that shall be kept holy: New Year's day, called the Circumcision; Twelfth Day, called the Epiphany; Candlemas, called the Purification of Mary; Matthias the twelve-messenger; the Annunciation, called the Annunciation of Mary; Palm Sunday; Easter day with the Monday and the Tuesday after; Philip and James the twelve-messengers; Ascension day, called the Ascension of the Lord; Whitsunday with the Monday and the Tuesday after; the Holy Trinity, called Trinity; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul the twelve-messengers; James the twelve-messenger; our Lady's departing, called the Assumption

**Note.** This order makes a second rank of its own: days that are "unhallowed in remembrance" (*ungefeiret in gedechtnus*). Their memory is kept, but they are not holy days.

**Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 74). This order keeps Corpus Christi, as a day to teach the right use of the Sacrament, and keeps the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary. The summer feasts are moved to Sunday for the harvest (§12.6.4, §12.8.9).

The Teschen list is one of the longest in the corpus. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 461):

> IX. Welche fest man halten soll. Uber die gemeine sontage sollen gehalten und feierlich begangen werden die hohen hauptfest unsers christlichen glaubens, darmitte dieselbe dem gemeinen volk mit vleiss vorgetragen und eingebieldet werden. Als nemlichen den tag Nativitatis Christi sampt dem anderen und drietten fest, den tag Circumcisionis Domini, Epipha., Conversionis Pauli, Purificationis Mariae, Mathiae Apost., Annunciationis Mariae, gruen donnerstag, charfreitag, der ostertag sampt dem nachvolgenden und drietten fest, Philippi et Jacobi, hiemmelfahrt Christi, pfingsten mit nachfolgenden feiertagen, demnach der heiligen dreifaltigkeit, Mariae gebuert, Johannis Baptistae, Petri et Pauli, Visitationis Mariae, Mariae Magdalenae, Jacobi Apost., Transfigurationis Domini, Bartholomei Apostoli, Decolationis Joannis, Mathei, Michaelis Arch., Simonis et Judae, Andreae Apostoli, Martini et Catharinae. An diesen beruerten festen mag man nach gelegenheit der zeit biessweilen alleine den vormittag feiern und nachmittag widerum ein jeder seines beruefs und handarbeit warten

IX. Which feasts shall be kept. Over and above the common Sundays shall be kept and solemnly celebrated the high chief feasts of our Christian faith, that the same may be diligently set forth and imprinted on the common people: namely the day of the Nativity of Christ with the second and third feast; the day of the Circumcision of the Lord; the Epiphany; the Conversion of Paul; the Purification of Mary; Matthias the apostle; the Annunciation of Mary; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; Easter day with the following and third feast; Philip and James; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsuntide with the following holy days; thereafter the holy Trinity; the Nativity of Mary; John the Baptist; Peter and Paul; the Visitation of Mary; Mary Magdalene; James the apostle; the Transfiguration of the Lord; Bartholomew the apostle; the Beheading of John; Matthew; Michael the archangel; Simon and Jude; Andrew the apostle; Martin and Catherine. On these aforesaid feasts one may, as the season serveth, sometimes keep holy the forenoon only, and in the afternoon every man attend again to his calling and handiwork

**Note.** Every day in Teschen is formally a "high chief feast". The real ranking is left to the season: in time of work any of them may be a half day.

**Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 662):

> Die fürnemsten fest und feiertäg aber weren dise: alle sonetag, aller apostl tag, den Cristag mit sambt sant Steffans tag und sant Joanes tag dofuer und in einen tag gefeiert, den Neuen jaerstag, der heiligen Dreikönigtag, Marie Liechmeß oder Rainigung, Marie Verkündung, Ostern und den montag henach, Auffart Christi, Pfingstag und montag hernach, Johannis des taufers, Marie Heimsuchung, Marie Himelfahrt, Marie Magdalene, sant Michael und Allerheiligen tag.

But the chiefest feasts and holy days should be these: all Sundays; all the apostles' days; Christmas, together with St Stephen's day and St John's day, kept holy therefor and in one day; New Year's day; the Three Kings' day; Mary's Candlemas or Purification; Mary's Annunciation; Easter and the Monday after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday and the Monday after; John the Baptist; Mary's Visitation; Mary's Assumption; Mary Magdalene; St Michael; and All Saints' day.

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## 12.6 Whole holy days and half holy days

In practice the most important mark of rank was civil: whether a day was a holy day for the whole of it, for the forenoon only, or not at all. Many orders give the working population this information in the form of a list of "whole" and "half" days, to be declared from the pulpit on the Sunday before. The half holy day, kept "until noon" or "until the sermon is ended", is the Lutheran successor of the late-medieval distinction between *festa fori* and lesser feasts. It is also the chief place where economic pressure (harvest, markets, craftsmen's work) shaped the calendar.

### 12.6.1 The half holy day: "until noon"

The form appears as early as Nicolaus Hausmann's Anhalt order of 1532, with "aller apostel tage fur mittage" (§12.5.7). It is then fixed by the Saxon order of 1539 and by Mecklenburg 1552 (both in §12.5.2): a sermon in the forenoon, communion if there are communicants, and work after noon. Other examples:

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 87):

> Die aposteltage sollen hinfürder auch, aber allein vormittag gefeiret werden, die pfarrkinder der alten wahren apostolischen lehr in den verordneten evangelien, item der heiligen apostel ihres glaubens und guten exempels erinnert und berichtet werden […] Wann die predig geschehen und das heilige abendmahl (so ferne communikanten sind) gehalten ist, soll jedermann diese tage nachmittag zu arbeiten frei sein. Es sollen aber die pfarrherren allezeit den nechsten sonntag zuvor die festa und aposteltag verkündigen und anzeigen, auf welchen tag in der wochen dieselbigen gefallen und das der aposteltag nicht lenger dann vormittag soll gefeiret werden, damit sich ein jeder hausvater habe darnach zu richten etc.

The apostles' days shall henceforth also be kept holy, but only in the forenoon, and the parishioners be reminded and instructed, in the appointed Gospels, of the old true apostolic doctrine, and also of the holy apostles' faith and good example […] When the sermon hath been held and the holy Supper (in so far as there be communicants) celebrated, every man shall be free to work on these days in the afternoon. But the parsons shall always, on the next Sunday before, proclaim and shew the feasts and apostles' days, on what day in the week the same fall, and that the apostles' day shall be kept holy no longer than the forenoon, that every householder may order himself thereafter, etc.

The city of Osnabrück had sermons five times a week, and so needed "no special holy days". **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 7/1, p. 259):

> Dewyle nu der wecken viffmal geprediket wert baven die sondagesprediken, so bedarve wy nener besondergen virdagen, damit men dem gemeinem volke nicht orsake geve to lediggande und in de kröge to gan und de tidt unnütlicken tobringen etc. Idt schall ock neen fest edder hillig dag geholden werden dann allene, dat man Gades wort predicken höre und Gott bidde und danke vor syne genade dorch Christum. De aposteldage sollen gefyret wurden wente to middage.

Now forasmuch as there is preaching five times in the week beside the Sunday sermons, we need no special holy days, that we give not the common people occasion to go idle, and to go into the taverns, and to spend the time unprofitably, etc. Neither shall any feast or holy day be kept save only that men may hear God's Word preached, and pray to God and thank him for his grace through Christ. The apostles' days shall be kept holy until noon.

In Waldeck the half day extends even to Good Friday. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, pp. 272–273):

> der tag des leidens Christi, so der carfreitag genennet wirdt, soll halb feierlich biß auff den mittag gehalttenn werden, des abents aber die sepultura Christi verhandelt werden […] Diese vorgeschriebene Feiertage ausserhalb den außgezogenen sollen gantz unnd durchauß gefeieret unnd dem Volck allwege des Sontags zuvor verkündiget werden […] S. Petri [und] Pauli, S. Jacobi, S. Bartholomei tag sol man vor mittag heylig halten, dem volck eyne predigt thun und darnach an ire arbeyt gehen lassen

the day of the Passion of Christ, which is called Good Friday, shall be kept half holy until noon, but in the evening the burial of Christ shall be handled […] These holy days aforewritten, beside those excepted, shall be kept holy wholly and throughout, and be proclaimed to the people always on the Sunday before […] St Peter and Paul's, St James's and St Bartholomew's day one shall keep holy before noon, make the people a sermon, and thereafter let them go to their work

**Note.** Waldeck's text is printed by the editor with a second recension set into the apparatus, and the two are not always easy to separate. In the other recension Michaelmas is kept "fur das virte heuptfest", as the fourth chief feast (p. 272).

#### 12.6.2 Tables of whole and half holy days

From the 1560s the orders of the Harz counties and of the Rhine and Main set out the whole and half days in formal lists.

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, pp. 239–240):

> Von gemeinen festen. Weil auch aus ungleichem halten der festage, viel unrichtigkeit einfellet, so sollen die pfarherren wissen, welche feiertage in dieser grafschaft ganz, welche aber nur halb gehalten werden. Diese nachfolgende fest helt man den ganzen tag durchaus feierlich. Den christag, sampt den zweien folgenden tagen, Stephani und Johannis. Den neuen jars tag. Den tag der offenbarung Christi, den man den tag der heiligen drei könige nennet. Den tag der reinigung Mariae. Den tag der verkündigung Mariae. Den ostertag, mit den zweien folgenden tagen. Den tag , der himmelfart Christi. Den tag der heiligen pfingsten, mit den zweien nechst folgenden tagen. Den tag Johannis des teufers. Den tag visitationis Mariae. Den tag Michaelis. […] Nachfolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiret. Der tag S. Andreae. Der tag des apostels S. Thomae. Der tag der bekerung S. Pauli. Der tag des apostels Matthiae. Der grüne donnerstag. Der charfreitag. Der tag Philippi Jacobi. Der tag Petri und Pauli. S. Jacobus tag. S. Laurentii tag. Der tag Bartholomei. Der tag Matthei. Der tag Simonis und Judae.

Of common feasts. Forasmuch also as much disorder ariseth from the unequal keeping of the feast days, the parsons shall know which holy days in this county are kept wholly, and which but half. These feasts following are kept holy the whole day throughout: Christmas day, together with the two days following, Stephen and John; New Year's day; the day of the manifestation of Christ, which is called the day of the Three Kings; the day of the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary; Easter day, with the two days following; the day of the Ascension of Christ; the day of holy Whitsuntide, with the two days next following; the day of John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael. […] The days following are kept but half holy: the day of St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; St James's day; St Laurence's day; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude.

At Wintzingerode the whole days (the same list as Mansfeld) are graded again by sermons. **Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung*** (Sehling 2, p. 256; after the Hohnstein order; undated):

> Und soll auf einen jeden tag zweimal geprediget und von allerhand arbeit denselben ganzen tag stille gehalten werden. Auf den dritten tag der treien hauptfeste als auf Johannistag, in den heiligen weinachten, auf den oster und pfingst dinstag soll nur ein mal gepredigt werden. Nachfolgende tage werden nur halb gefeiret: Der tag des apostels S. Andreae. Der tag des apostels S. Thomae. Der tag der bekerung S. Pauli. Der tag des apostels S. Matthiae. Der grüne donnerstag. Der charfreitag. Der tag Philippi Jacobi. Der tag Petri und Pauli. Der tag Mariae Magdalenae. Der tag S. Jacobi. Der tag Bartholomaei. Der tag Mathaei. Der tag Simonis, und Judae. […] Es sollen auch allezeit die fest und aposteltage den sontag zuvor, darmit sich das volk darnach zu richten, vorkündiget und abgesaget, darneben vormeldet, welche ganz und welche halb solen gefeiret werden.

And on every such day there shall be preaching twice, and rest kept from all manner of work the same whole day. On the third day of the three chief feasts, as on St John's day in holy Christmas, and on the Easter and Whitsun Tuesday, there shall be preaching but once. The days following are kept but half holy: the day of the apostle St Andrew; the day of the apostle St Thomas; the day of the conversion of St Paul; the day of the apostle St Matthias; Maundy Thursday; Good Friday; the day of Philip and James; the day of Peter and Paul; the day of Mary Magdalene; the day of St James; the day of Bartholomew; the day of Matthew; the day of Simon and Jude. […] Also the feasts and apostles' days shall always be proclaimed and bidden on the Sunday before, that the people may order themselves thereafter, and withal it shall be declared which shall be kept wholly and which half.

In Pfalz-Zweibrücken the duchy's *Statthalter* and councillors clarify the church order of 1557, which had been read in different ways. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1561** (Sehling 18, pp. 297–298):

> Nemlich allso, daß hinfurther nachvollgennde Feyrtag fur hohe fest zuhallten, die gleich den Sonntagen vor- unnd nachmittag sollend gefeyret werdenn, als: […] 1. Nativitatis, daß ist der Christag. 2. Circumcisionis, die beschneidung Christi. 3. Epiphaniae, daß ist der hailigen drei König tag. 4. Purificationis, daß ist der tag der opfferung Christi. 5. Annuntiationis, der tag, da Christus inn der Jungkfrawen leib empfangen ist wordenn. 6. Caene Domini, der Grun Donnerstag. 7. Passionis Domini, der Charfreittag. 8. Ascensionis Domini, daß ist die Himmelfarth Christi. Waß aber die uberigen gemaine feyrtag, alsda seindt der Apostell tag, Nemlich Sanct Mathias, Philippi Jacobi, Petri unnd Pauli, […] Andree und Thomastag, item S. Johannstag, Visitationis Marie, S. Michelstag […] und die zween vollgennde nach dem Christag, Ostern unnd Pfingsten belanngt, an denen soll hinfurther allain morgents vor mittag Gottes Wortt verkhundigt werdenn. Doch dergestallt, daß ann solchen tagen vor mittag bei straff zehen gulden niemandts erlaubt seie, felldt […] oder anndere arbaitt anzufahen, auch sein Kram oder laden nit auffzuthun oder dergleichen ettwas zuhandtieren, die Predig seie dann beschehen. Nach gethaner Predig aber soll niemandt zufeyren gezwungen, sonnder allßdann jederman zuarbaitten erlaubt sein.

Namely thus: that henceforth the holy days following are to be kept for high feasts, which shall be kept holy like the Sundays before and after noon, to wit: […] 1. The Nativity, that is, Christmas day. 2. The Circumcision, the circumcising of Christ. 3. The Epiphany, that is, the holy Three Kings' day. 4. The Purification, that is, the day of the offering of Christ. 5. The Annunciation, the day whereon Christ was conceived in the Virgin's womb. 6. The Supper of the Lord, Maundy Thursday. 7. The Passion of the Lord, Good Friday. 8. The Ascension of the Lord, that is, Christ's going up to heaven. But as touching the other common holy days, which are the apostles' days, namely St Matthias, Philip and James, Peter and Paul, […] Andrew's and Thomas's day, item St John's day, the Visitation of Mary, St Michael's day […] and the two following after Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide: on these God's Word shall henceforth be proclaimed only in the morning before noon. Yet in such wise that on such days before noon no man be suffered, on pain of ten gulden, to begin field-work or other work, nor to open his booth or shop, or to handle any such thing, until the sermon be done. But after the sermon is done, no man shall be compelled to keep holy, but every man shall then be free to work.

**Note.** Easter and Whitsunday fall on Sundays and are not listed. The second and third days of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide are half days here. So are John the Baptist, the Visitation and Michaelmas, which Mecklenburg had kept whole or nearly so.

In the Landau ordinance the "whole" days are only four, and they are called high feasts of Christ. **Landau, *Feiertagsordnung* of the town council, 1562** (Sehling 19/1, p. 61):

> Und seind das die hohen fest des herrn Christi, so gleich dem sontag durchauß gefeirt werden sollen: Erstlich der tag nativitatis oder geburt Christi sampt dem andern volgenden tag. Der tag circumcisionis oder der beschneidung Christi. Der tag epiphaniae, das ist der erscheinung oder offenbarung Christi, den man nennet der h[eiligen] drey könig tag. Jede montag nach ostern unnd pfingsten. Andere feiertag, so allein biß auff mittag gehalten werdenn sollen: Der tag der opferung Christi, genant purificationis Mariae. Der tag annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi. Der tag caenae domini, der grün durstag genent, daran von des hernn abentmal gepredigt wirdt. […] Der tag passionis domini oder des leidens unnd sterbens Christi, der karfreitag genent. Der tag ascensionis oder himelfarth Christi. Item die tag der aposteln. Der tag S[anct] Johannis des teuffers. Der tag visitationis Mariae. Der tag Michaelis von wegen der leer von den heiligen engeln. Unnd an solchen apostel- und feiertagen auserhalb der sontag unnd hohen fest hierbeiermelt mag ein jeder burger nach mittag sein geschefft unnd arbeit seiner gelegenheit nach wol verrichtenn.

And these are the high feasts of the Lord Christ which shall be kept holy throughout like the Sunday: first, the day of the Nativity or birth of Christ, with the second day following; the day of the Circumcision of Christ; the day of the Epiphany, that is, of the appearing or manifestation of Christ, which is called the holy Three Kings' day; each Monday after Easter and Whitsuntide. Other holy days, which shall be kept only until noon: the day of the offering of Christ, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ; the day of the Lord's Supper, called Maundy Thursday, whereon is preached of the Lord's Supper; […] the day of the Passion of the Lord, or of the suffering and death of Christ, called Good Friday; the day of the Ascension of Christ; item the days of the apostles; the day of St John the Baptist; the day of the Visitation of Mary; the day of Michael, because of the doctrine of the holy angels. And on such apostles' and holy days, beside the Sundays and the high feasts here mentioned, every burgher may well do his business and work after noon, as it serveth him.

**Note.** In Landau even the Ascension is a half day. The high feasts that fall on weekdays, Christmas, New Year and Epiphany, are whole days. So are the Mondays of Easter and Whitsuntide.

The Pfalz-Veldenz chapter is headed "[X.] Ordnung der Feirtage. [1. Halbe und ganze Feiertage]". It gives a reason for keeping the half days. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 518):

> so ist doch nit gerathen, die gewohneten Feirtag zu endern oder abzustellen. Sintemahl sie gemeiner kürchen dohin dienstlich, das sie bestimbte zeitt wiß und verursacht werde, die Predig und Administration der Sacramenten zu besuchen, dieweil sonnst (wie die erfahrung gibt) das volckh inn den wochenpredigten gar saumhafft unnd fahrlessig ist, wann ihnen erlaubt zu arbeitten. Auch ist ohne das nöttig, das man im jahr etliche gemeine Bettag halte für das gantze Volckh, darzu die verordnete halbe Feyrtage am aller bequembsten sein mögen, do sie ohne Superstition gehalten werden, so wehre auch nit nutzlich, dise tag wider anfangen gantz zu feyren, dann (wie wir sehen) ist der Mißbrauch der Feyrtag sehr groß, gar wenig besuchen Mittags […] Predigen, werden vilmehr mit […] dantzen, spilen, zechen und anndern leichtfertigen dingen zubracht. Derohalben, wölche tag bißanhero gantz oder halb gefeyrt worden, sollen noch also hifürter nach diser Ordnung gehalten werden, dann hierin unnötig, das volckh abermahl irrig zu machen.

yet it is not advisable to change or abolish the accustomed holy days, since they serve the common Church to this end, that it may know appointed times, and be moved to resort to the sermon and the administration of the sacraments; for otherwise (as experience sheweth) the people are very slack and negligent at the week-day sermons, when they are suffered to work. Besides, it is needful that certain common days of prayer be kept in the year for the whole people, for which the appointed half holy days may be most convenient, if they be kept without superstition. Nor were it profitable to begin again to keep these days wholly; for (as we see) the abuse of holy days is very great: very few resort to the midday sermons, but they are rather spent in dancing, playing, carousing and other light things. Therefore the days which hitherto have been kept wholly or half shall be kept so henceforth according to this order; for herein it is needless to lead the people astray once more.

The list itself makes the half days into days of prayer. **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 519):

> Item die zwen folgende tag nach dem Christag, zwen nach Ostern und zwen nach Pfingsten. An disen tagen soll man allein vor Mittag predigen unnd, so Communicanten do seindt nach der Predig, soll man die Letaney singen oder lesen, dann dise tag sollen für gemeine Bettage dem Volckh verkhündiget und gehaltten werden.

Item the two days following after Christmas, two after Easter and two after Whitsuntide. On these days one shall preach before noon only, and, if there be communicants, after the sermon one shall sing or read the Litany; for these days shall be proclaimed and kept for common days of prayer for the people.

**Note.** The whole days here are Christmas, Circumcision, Epiphany, Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday and Ascension. The half days are the apostles, Good Friday, John the Baptist, the Visitation, Michaelmas, and the second and third days of the three great feasts. Like Waldeck 1556 (§12.6.1), this order ranks Good Friday below Maundy Thursday.

The Ysenburg-Ronneburg list grades each day separately, by sermons, forenoon and afternoon. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 583):

> Festum Circumcisionis Christi [...] welchs sonst der new jahrs [tag] genänt, soll ganz gefeyert undt gehalten werden. Epiphania Domini oder Trium Regum soll auch vor unndt nach mittag mit einer predig gefeyert werden. Purificationis Mariae soll denn halben tag gefeyert werdenn. Dies Matthiae Apostoli auch nur ein halben tag. Annunciationis Mariae soll den halben tag gehalten werdenn. Nota: Weil dieses fest bisweilenn in die karwochenn gefelt, sols alsdann umbgangen werdenn. Grundonnerstag undt der charfreittag soll ein iglicher nur vor mittag gehaltenn werdenn. Der ostertag unndt ostermontag sollen beyde vor undt nach mittag mit predigten versehen werden, der osterdinstag nur vor mittag.

The feast of the Circumcision of Christ [...] which is otherwise called New Year's day, shall be kept holy and held wholly. The Epiphany of the Lord, or the Three Kings, shall also be kept holy before and after noon with a sermon. The Purification of Mary shall be kept holy the half day. The day of Matthias the apostle also but half a day. The Annunciation of Mary shall be kept the half day. Note: because this feast sometimes falleth in Holy Week, it shall then be passed over. Maundy Thursday and Good Friday shall each be kept before noon only. Easter day and Easter Monday shall both be furnished with sermons before and after noon; Easter Tuesday before noon only.

The list continues with the summer days, which are fitted to the harvest and to the market at Gelnhausen. **Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 583):

> Der tag Johannis Baptistae soll wegen des marktags zu Gelnhausenn nur vor mittag mit einer predigt celebrirt werdenn. [...] Petri unndt Pauli unndt der tag Visitationis Mariae fallen gemeiniglich in einer wochenn undt zur erndezeit, soll alsdann under den beydenn der am gelegestenn mit einer predigt vor mittag gehalten werdenn. Bartholomaei, Matthaei, Michaelis, Simonis Judae, S. Tomas, diese sollenn nur vor mittag gehaltenn werdenn. Der christtag unndt S. Stephans tag soll vor unndt nach mittag mit predigten verrichtet werden. S. Johanns tag aber, des evangelistenn, mag nur mit einer predigt vor mittag beschlossenn werdenn.

The day of John the Baptist, because of the market day at Gelnhausen, shall be celebrated only before noon with a sermon. [...] Peter and Paul and the day of the Visitation of Mary commonly fall in one week and in harvest-time; then of the two, the one that is most convenient shall be kept with a sermon before noon. Bartholomew, Matthew, Michael, Simon and Jude, St Thomas, these shall be kept only before noon. Christmas day and St Stephen's day shall be performed with sermons before and after noon. But St John the Evangelist's day may be concluded with one sermon only before noon.

The Nassau-Weilburg text of 1576 lists twelve feasts, and in 1618 a sentence was added to divide them. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576, with the *Agende* of 1618** (Sehling 10, p. 228):

> Diese Feyertage, so zur gedächtnuß der wolthaten unsers Herrn Jhesu Christi verordenet seind, werden mit Gesang, Predigen unnd Communion gleich den gemeinen Sontagen gehalten, allein daß die Introitus, Sequentz und andere Geseng de Tempore für die andern gemeine Gesenge gebraucht werden. Der Aposteln tage aber sollen alle mit einer Predigt gehalten werden.

These holy days, which are ordained for the remembrance of the benefits of our Lord Jesus Christ, are kept with chant, sermons and communion like the common Sundays; only that the introits, sequences and other chants *de tempore* are used instead of the other common chants. But the apostles' days shall all be kept with one sermon.

The 1618 *Agende* reads instead. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Agende*, 1618** (Sehling 10, p. 228; in the editor's apparatus):

> den gemeinen Sontagen gleich und gantz feyrlich celebrirt. Der dritte Tag aber zu Weihenachten, Ostern und Pfingsten sampt dem Tag Visitationis Mariae, S. Iohannis Baptistae wie auch Michaelis und der Heyligen Apostel Tage sollen mit einer Predigt gehalten werden, unnd gehet das Volck nach Mittag widerumb zu seiner Arbeit. Damit aber das gemeine Volck sich destobaß darnach hab zu richten, so sollen unsere Kirchendiener allewegen den Sontag zuvor von der Cantzel

> verkündigen, was für Fest- und Feyertage dieselbige zukünfftige Wochen einfallen und ob die mit einer Predigt halb oder gantz feyerlich nach der Kirchenordnung sollen gehalten werden.

celebrated like the common Sundays and wholly solemnly. But the third day at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, together with the day of the Visitation of Mary, of St John the Baptist, and also Michaelmas and the holy apostles' days, shall be kept with one sermon, and the people go again to their work after noon. But that the common people may the better order themselves thereafter, our ministers shall always on the Sunday before proclaim from the pulpit what feasts and holy days fall in the same coming week, and whether they shall be kept half with one sermon, or wholly solemnly, according to the church order.

The Nassau-Weilburg rule in its final form. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Visitationsabschied*, 1609** (Sehling 10, p. 352):

> Von feiertagen undt wochenpredigten 1. Wir wollen unndt verordnen, daß hienfuro die gantze feyertage mit zwo predigten unndt andern göttlichen ubungen, der dritte tag in den weyhnacht-, oster- unndt pfingstfeyertagen mit einer predigt, wie auch der tag Johannis Baptistae, visitationis Mariae unndt Michaelis gleich den aposteltagen, halb feyerlich gehalten werden unndt die leute nach mittag, wann der gottesdienst verrichtet, ahn ihre arbeit gehen. […] 3. Wo uff den gründonnerstags, qui dies institutionis caenae dominicae est, daß nachtmal deß herrn zue celebriren gewönlich, darbey laßen wir es verpleiben, sonsten soll derselbige sampt dem charfreytag nur halb feyerlich gehalten werden

Of holy days and week-day sermons. 1. We will and ordain that henceforth the whole holy days be kept with two sermons and other divine exercises; the third day in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun holy days with one sermon; as also the day of John the Baptist, of the Visitation of Mary, and of Michael, like the apostles' days, half solemnly; and that the people go to their work after noon, when the divine service is performed. […] 3. Where it is wont to celebrate the Lord's Supper on Maundy Thursday, *which is the day of the institution of the Lord's Supper*, we let it remain so; otherwise the same, together with Good Friday, shall be kept but half solemnly

Ritzebüttel has a Low German list in two columns. **Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 559):

> Die virdage overst, an welckeren unse gadesdienst in der kercken geholden wert, sin desse na beschrevene und sint den ganzen dag virlich. Alle sondage. Die ersten twe dage […] in den winachten Nihe jars dag. Die ersten 2 dage in den h. pfingsten. Drie könig dag. Item […] Johannis Baptistae dag. Marien berggang. S. Michaelen dae;. lichtmessen dag. Marien redeschop. Die ersten 2 dage in der heil, paschen. Der herren hemmelfart. De na vortekenden dage werden virlick geholden up den halven dag edder bet to middage umb der predige willen, also: Alle apostel dage. Dingstag in den paschen. Pingesten. Marien Magdalenen dag. Pauli bekehrunge dag. Aller hilligen dag.

But the holy days whereon our divine service is held in the church are these hereafter written, and are holy the whole day: all Sundays; the first two days in Christmas; New Year's day; the first two days in holy Whitsuntide; the Three Kings' day; item St John the Baptist's day; Mary's going over the hills; St Michael's day; Candlemas day; Mary's message; the first two days in holy Easter; the Lord's Ascension. The days hereafter noted are kept holy for the half day, or until noon, for the sermon's sake, thus: all apostles' days; the Tuesday in Easter; [the Tuesday in] Whitsuntide; Mary Magdalene's day; St Paul's conversion day; All Saints' day.

**Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 9, p. 356):

> Von den feyertagen, cap. 1 Nachvolgende tage sollen den gantzen tag feyerlich gehalten und an denselben keine ausserliche, grobe arbeit verrichtet, sondern mit predigen, singen, beten, lesen und betrachtung gottliches worts zubracht werden: Alle sontage, der tag der geburt Christi sambt zweien nachvolgenden tagen, der newe jars tag oder circumcisionis, der tag epiphaniae […] der tag der opferung Christi im tempel, genant purificationis Mariae, der tag annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi […] der tag coenae Domini […] der tag passionis Christi […] der ostertag und uferstehung des hern Christi sambt volgendem montag und dinstag, […] der tag ascensionis oder uffhart Christi zum hiemel, der pfingstdag sambt volgenden montag und dinstag. Uber das sollen volgende tage vormittage feirlich gehalten und daran geprediget werden: alle aposteltage, sanct Johannis des tauffers tag, visitationis Mariae

Of the holy days, chapter 1. The days following shall be kept holy the whole day, and no outward gross work be done thereon, but they be spent with preaching, singing, praying, reading and meditating of God's Word: all Sundays; the day of the birth of Christ with two days following; New Year's day, or the Circumcision; the day of the Epiphany […] the day of the offering of Christ in the temple, called the Purification of Mary; the day of the Annunciation of Mary or Conception of Christ […] the day of the Lord's Supper […] the day of the Passion of Christ […] Easter day and the resurrection of the Lord Christ, with the following

Monday and Tuesday, […] the day of the Ascension, or of Christ's going up to heaven; Whitsunday with the following Monday and Tuesday. Beside these the days following shall be kept holy in the forenoon, and preaching held thereon: all apostles' days, St John the Baptist's day, the Visitation of Mary

**Leiningen-Hardenburg, *Kirchenordnungsmandat* for Dürkheim, 1584** (Sehling 19/1, pp. 277–278):

> Nachdem in unserer kirchenordnung versehen, das man alle Son- und hohen Festag, als den heyligen Oster-, Pfingst und Cristag sambt dem negst nachvolgenden tag, deßgleichen auch den neuen jars tag, der heyligen drei könig tag, Marie Lichtmeß, Marie verkundigung und Himelfart Cristi […] den gantzen tag durchaus feyren und heyligen, auch vor- und nachmittag gottes wort verkundigen und predigen soll […] Sovil aber der heyligen apostel tag anbelangt, die sollen vormittag mit verkhundigung gottliches worts gehalten und gefeirt werden, aber nach volendter predig mag ein jeder in sein arbait dretten.

Whereas it is provided in our church order that all Sundays and high feast days, as the holy Easter, Whitsun and Christmas day, together with the next day following, likewise also New Year's day, the holy Three Kings' day, Mary's Candlemas, Mary's Annunciation and the Ascension of Christ […] shall be kept holy and hallowed the whole day throughout, and God's Word be proclaimed and preached before and after noon […] But as touching the holy apostles' days, these shall be kept and hallowed in the forenoon with the proclaiming of God's Word; but after the sermon is ended every man may go to his work.

In the city of Osnabrück a local day of penance stands among the half days. **Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613** (Sehling 7/1, p. 267):

> Folgende tag werden nur mit einer predigt halb gefeyret: 1. Johannis evangelistae tag. 2. Der tag Mariae reinigung. 3. Der tag Matthiae apostoli. 4. Der eilfte tag Martii, an welchem eine bußpredigt wegen deß anno 1613 am 11. Martii erlittenen brandschadens gehalten wird. Item Osterd. und Pfingstdinstag. 5. Der tag der verkündigung Mariae. 6. Der tag Philippi und Jacobi. 7. Der tag Johannis baptistae. 8. Der tag Petri und Pauli. 9. Der tag der heimsuchung Mariae. 10. Der tag Jacobi apostoli. 11. Der tag Bartholomaei, welcher ein tag der danksagung ist vor die eingeerndte frücht. 12. Der tag Matthaei. 13. Der tag Simonis und Judae. 14. Der tag Andreae.

The days following are kept but half holy, with one sermon: 1. St John the Evangelist's day. 2. The day of the Purification of Mary. 3. The day of Matthias the apostle. 4. The eleventh day of March, whereon a sermon of repentance is held because of the damage by fire suffered on the 11th of March in the year 1613. Item Easter Tuesday and Whitsun Tuesday. 5. The day of the Annunciation of Mary. 6. The day of Philip and James. 7. The day of John the Baptist. 8. The day of Peter and Paul. 9. The day of the Visitation of Mary. 10. The day of James the apostle. 11. The day of Bartholomew, which is a day of thanksgiving for the fruits gathered in. 12. The day of Matthew. 13. The day of Simon and Jude. 14. The day of Andrew.

**Note.** In Osnabrück St Bartholomew's day, not Michaelmas, is the harvest thanksgiving. The sentence before this list puts St Stephen's day among the days "nur mit zweyen predigten ganz gefeyret", kept wholly but with two sermons only. The editor explains that the chief feasts had three: the catechism sermon, the chief (Gospel) sermon and the Epistle sermon.

At Tecklenburg the half day is defined by the sermon alone. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 245):

> Up doße apostel- und andere kleine festdage sal nemant onder dem sermone arbeiden; darvoir edder na tho arbeyden, sal vryg staen.

On these apostles' and other small feast days no man shall work during the sermon; to work before or after it shall be free.

A town's report to the visitors gives the rule in two lines. **Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 2, p. 486):

> Alle aposteltage wird gepredigt und vor mittags gefeiret. In den hohen festtagen feieret man den ganzen tag, predigt zweimal.

On all apostles' days there is preaching, and holy day is kept before noon. On the high feast days holy day is kept the whole day, and there is preaching twice.

Brieg is a Silesian order in which the three Marian feasts of Christ, with John the Baptist and Michaelmas, are whole days. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592** (Sehling 3, p. 445):

> Die drei Marien-fest, als Annunciationis, Visitationis und Purificationis, item festum Johannis Baptae und Michaelis sollen den ganzen tag feierlich, wie sie fallen, gehalten werden; die apostelfest aber mit einer predigt, die da früh soll geschehen, doch dass die leute können zur kirchen kommen.

The three feasts of Mary, as the Annunciation, the Visitation and the Purification, item the feast of John the Baptist and of Michael, shall be kept solemnly the whole day, as they fall; but the apostles' feasts with one sermon, which shall be held early, yet so that the people can come to church.

#### 12.6.3 Counting the rank in sermons

Many orders measure a day by its number of sermons: three, two, or one. At Penig the second day of a high feast has two sermons and the last day one.

**Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 1, p. 634):

> Alle hohe fest geschehen den ersten tag drei predigten zur matin, zum ampt und vesper zeiten, folgenden festtag zwo, zum letzten eine.

On all high feasts there are three sermons on the first day, at the times of matins, the office and vespers; on the following feast day two; on the last, one.

In Henneberg the four chief feasts have two sermons and all other feasts one. The Ascension is one of the four. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, pp. 312–313):

> Von den festen. Uber die sontag sollen zu betrachtung der wolthaten Jesu Christi, unsers geliebten herrn und heilands, nachfolgende festtage feierlich gehalten, und darauf die gewönlichen evangelia mit den ceremonien, wie an den sontagen geordnet, gehandelt werden. Erstlich die vier heupt fest, mit zweien predigten, vor und nach mittage, als: Der erst und ander christag. Der erst und ander ostertag. Auffartstag. Erst und ander pfingstag. Desgleichen auch Circumcisionis. Trium regum. Purificationis oder lichtmess. Zum andern die gewöhnliche andere festa, als: Aller apostel tage. Item : Pauli bekehrung. Annunciationis. Donnerstag und freitag in der palmwochen. Johannis Baptistae. Visitationis. Mariae Magdalenae. Michaelis, von den engeln. Diese alle sollen erstlich auf den sontag zuvor verkündiget, darnach wenn und wie sie gefallen, […] nachfolgender gestalt mit einer predigt gehalten werden. […] Und sol als denn des folgenden morgends mit den ceremonien, wie auf die gemeine sontage, doch one orgeln, gehalten werden. Wann nun solche predigt vor mittage volbracht ist, sol ein jeder an seine gebürende arbeit und beruf gehen.

Of the feasts. Over and above the Sundays, for the considering of the benefits of Jesus Christ, our beloved Lord and Saviour, these feast days following shall be kept solemnly, and thereon the wonted Gospels handled with the ceremonies as ordained on the Sundays. First, the four chief feasts, with two sermons, before and after noon, as: the first and second Christmas day; the first and second Easter day; Ascension day; the first and second Whitsunday. Likewise also the Circumcision, the Three Kings, the Purification or Candlemas. Secondly the wonted other feasts, as: all apostles' days; item St Paul's conversion; the Annunciation; Thursday and Friday in Palm week; John the Baptist; the Visitation; Mary Magdalene; Michael, of the angels. All these shall first be proclaimed on the Sunday before, and thereafter, when and as they fall, […] be kept in manner following with one sermon. […] And then on the following morning it shall be kept with the ceremonies as on the common Sundays, yet without the organs. And when such sermon is performed before noon, every man shall go to his due work and calling.

**Note.** In Henneberg the Annunciation is a lower-rank feast, but the Circumcision, Epiphany and Purification go with the chief feasts. Also on the lower feasts the organ is silent.

#### 12.6.4 Harvest, markets and the working year

The rank of the summer feasts was often cut down because of the harvest. The feasts of Peter and Paul (29 June), the Visitation (2 July), James (25 July), Mary Magdalene (22 July), Laurence (10 August), the Assumption (15 August) and Bartholomew (24 August) are the ones most affected.

The Mediasch synod gives the only technical term for the half day in the corpus, *intercise*. **Transylvanian Saxons, Mediasch synod, 1578** (Sehling 24, pp. 427–428; the report printed in the apparatus from Teutsch's *Urkundenbuch*):

> In hac synodo ex deliberatione pastorum quorundam remota fuerunt duo festa apostolorum Petri et Pauli et divi Iacobi propter opera rustica, quae passim in istum mensem incidunt disputatoque de celebratione aliorum festorum apostolis dedicatorum conclusum est, ut isti apostolici dies intercise, hoc [...] est dimidiatim sacri haberentur et post officium matutinum sacrum concessum liberumque sit. cuilibet operas faciendi manuarias, dies autem domini nostri Iesu Christi ut Annunciationis, Ascensionis, Paschatis, Pentecostes, Nativitatis totaliter.

In this synod, by the deliberation of certain pastors, two feasts of the apostles, of Peter and Paul and of St James, were removed because of the country works which everywhere fall in that month; and, it being disputed of the celebration of the other feasts dedicated to the apostles, it was concluded that these apostolic days should be held holy *intercise*, that is, by halves, and that after the morning office it be granted and free to every man to do handiwork; but the days of our Lord Jesus Christ, as the Annunciation, the Ascension, Easter, Pentecost, the Nativity, wholly.

**Note.** *Intercisi dies* was the Roman calendar's term for days that were holy in the morning and evening but lawful for business in between.

The Burzenland article is headed *De feriis hebdomadatibus*. **Burzenland (Transylvania), *Visitationsartikel*, 1578** (Sehling 24, p. 452; German version B in the apparatus):

> Der wochen gemeiner feuer-täge wegen ist verordnet von der geistlicher universität, daß sie irer alle vom cantzel sollen verkündiget werden. Doch sollen sie voriges mißbrauchs wegen nur biß auf den mittag gefeyert werden mit handlung des worts Gottes und der heiligen sacramente. Denmnach kan ein jeder seiner und gemeiner arbeit auswarten.

Concerning the common holy days of the week, it is ordained by the spiritual university that they shall all be proclaimed from the pulpit. Yet because of the former abuse they shall be kept holy only until noon, with the handling of God's Word and the holy sacraments. Thereafter every man may attend to his own and the common work.

**Note.** The Latin note in the same apparatus records how the article went: it had been abolished "sic ut nullum divorum festum celebraretur", so that no saint's feast was celebrated, and was brought back at the synod of Birthälm in 1580.

In Mansfeld the apostles' Gospels in the harvest are moved to the Sunday, but only in the villages. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 240):

> Nach dem aber in der ernte zeit die tage Petri Pauli und Jacobi gefallen, und die leute in solcher zeit an der arbeit nicht gerne verhindert werden, so können dieselbigen evangelia obgetachter tage, auf den dörfern, ein jedes auf nehest volgenden sontag verleget werden. In stedten aber kan man sie halten auf den tag, darauf sie gefallen oder komen, wo sie auf einen sonnabent kemen, auch auf die nehesten sontag transferirt werden.

But forasmuch as the days of Peter and Paul and of James fall in the harvest-time, and the people are loath at that time to be hindered at their work, the Gospels of the said days may in the villages be laid, each one, on the next following Sunday. But in the towns one may keep them on the day whereon they fall or come; if they come on a Saturday, they may also be transferred to the next Sunday.

Nassau-Dillenburg moves the whole block of summer feasts to Sunday. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 74):

> Sanct Johans des tauffers tag, item sanct Peter unnd Paulus, Maria haimsuchung, visitationis genant, sanct Maria Magdalenen tag, sanct Jacobs, des apostels, sanct Laurentius, Maria Hymmelfart tag. Diese alle, dieweil sie in der rechten erndten khomen, sollen auff den nechsten sonttag nach dem calendertag gehalten werden, sover sie nit auff den sontag gefallen. Eß soll auch ein jeglicher pharher auff die sontag, darauff jetztbenante feiertag verlegt, nach mittag fur der khinderzucht das evangelion, so auff den tag zuhalten verordent ist, predigen.

St John the Baptist's day; item St Peter and Paul; Mary's Visitation, called *visitationis*; St Mary Magdalene's day; St James the apostle's; St Laurence; the day of Mary's Assumption. All these, because they come in the very harvest, shall be kept on the next Sunday after the calendar day, unless they fall on the Sunday. And every parson shall, on the Sundays to which the said holy days are removed, preach after noon, before the catechising of the children, the Gospel appointed to be kept for that day.

**Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590** (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

> Der Tag Petri und Pauli. Der Tag visitationis Mariae. Der Tag Iacobi Apostoli. Der Tag Bartholomaei. Weil gemeldte Apostel Fest in die Ernde fallen, sollen sie allein vor Mittag gefeyret werden.

The day of Peter and Paul. The day of the Visitation of Mary. The day of James the apostle. The day of Bartholomew. Because the said apostles' feasts fall in the harvest, they shall be kept holy before noon only.

To avoid too many summer holy days, Veit Dietrich moves the Visitation to 15 August, where it takes the place of the Assumption. **Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 538):

> Weil aber gemeinlich das fest Visitationis Marie in ein wochen, mit S.Peter und Paul felt und der feiertage umb der feldarbeit willen dazumal zu vil wöllen sein, ists also bedacht, das solchs fest Visitationis Marie auf den 15.tag Augusti verschoben wer, da man sonst das fest von der Himelfart Marie helt, welchs doch kein grund in der schrift und zu großer abgötterei vil ursach geben hat. Darumb soll man auf solchen tag Assumptionis die historien halten von der Heimsuchung, welche in der schrift gegründet und derhalb ein nütze lehr geben kan.

But since the feast of the Visitation of Mary commonly falleth in one week with St Peter and Paul, and the holy days would be too many at that time because of the field-work, it is thus devised that the same feast of the Visitation of Mary be put off to the fifteenth day of August, whereon otherwise the feast of the Ascension of Mary is kept, which yet hath no ground in the Scripture and hath given much occasion to great idolatry. Therefore on that day of the Assumption one shall hold the history of the Visitation, which is grounded in the Scripture and can therefore give a profitable doctrine.

**Note.** The same text is repeated in Hohenlohe 1578 (Sehling 15, p. 296), Wolfstein 1574 (Sehling 13, p. 587) and a Schwäbisch Hall draft of 1614 (Sehling 17/1, p. 191).

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## 12.7 How many days: the high feasts and their following days

The late-medieval octave, a week-long observance of a great feast, has left almost no trace. Its place is taken by the "following days" (*nachfolgende Tage*, *Feiertage*) of Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. How many of them are kept, and how fully, is itself a mark of rank.

- **Three days** in all the Bugenhagen orders (§12.5.4), in Saxony, Mecklenburg and their successors (§12.5.2), and in Regensburg, Thorn, Danzig, the Harz counties and Schwarzburg.
- **Two days** (the feast and the next day) in the Württemberg family (§12.5.3), in the Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 and its successors (§12.8.3), and in Kurpfalz.
- **A graded third day**: the third day is still a holy day but with fewer sermons, no communion, or no figural music.

### 12.7.1 Three days

**Amt Grimma, *Generalia der dorfer*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 576):

> Die hohe feste sollen allzeit drei tag mit predigen und andern cerimonien ganz feierlich gehalten, und in den messen, so communicanten vorhanden, messgewant gebraucht werden.

The high feasts shall always be kept three days, wholly solemnly, with preaching and other ceremonies, and in the masses, where there are communicants, the mass vestment be used.

**Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587** (Sehling 2, p. 137):

> Die drei hauptfeste weihenachten, ostern und pfingsten sollen drei tage feierlich gehalten werden, die ersten zween tage vor und nachmittage, der dritte aber allein vormittag mit predigten und do communicanten vorhanden, sollten alle drei tage das ampt gehalten werden. Gleichfalls sollen vor und nachmittag feierlich gehalten und solenniter celebriert werden, diese nechst folgende fest, als: Circumcisionis, Trium regum oder Epiphaniae, Purificationis […] Adnunciationis […] Mariae Virginis, Visitationis […] Johannis Baptistae, S. Michaelis.

The three chief feasts, Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide, shall be kept solemnly three days: the first two days before and after noon, but the third in the forenoon only, with sermons; and where there be communicants, the office shall be held on all three days. Likewise these feasts next following shall be kept solemnly before and after noon and celebrated with solemnity, as: the

Circumcision; the Three Kings or Epiphany; the Purification, the Annunciation and the Visitation of the Virgin Mary; John the Baptist; St Michael.

The St Mary's order at Danzig made the third day lesser, with two early sermons. In the margin a sixteenth-century hand wrote the contrary. **Danzig, draft *Feiertagsordnung* and St Mary's order of 1567** (Sehling 4, p. 187):

> Der dritte festtag soll gleich den andern zween gehalten werden.

The third feast day shall be kept like the other two.

At Regensburg all three days are kept, but the third has neither communion nor the midday sermon. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567** (Sehling 13, p. 475):

> An festen Christi, allen und jeden, wird neben den predigten frue auch das abendmahl gehalten und derhalben abends zuvor auch die vesper umb der communicanten willen. An Weihnachten, Ostern und Pfingsten wird doch das abendmahl nur die ersten zween tage gehalten und den dritten tag, als dem erichtag, die mittagspredig in beiden kirchen unterlassen, wie unten volget.

On the feasts of Christ, each and every one, the Supper is held beside the sermons in the morning, and therefore also vespers on the evening before, for the communicants' sake. Yet at Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide the Supper is held only the first two days, and on the third day, being the Tuesday, the midday sermon is left off in both churches, as followeth below.

In Prince Bernhard's Anhalt order the third day is graded by its music. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 569):

> Zu hohen festen soll man zwene heilige tage figural und den dritten tag den lateinischen coral und den sequens de tempore singen.

On high feasts one shall sing two holy days in figural music, and on the third day the Latin plain-song and the sequence *de tempore*.

The Wintzingerode order (§12.6.2) and Penig 1575 (§12.6.3) also make the third day lesser, with one sermon instead of two or three. Nassau-Weilburg 1609 (§12.6.2) makes it a half holy day.

### 12.7.2 Two days, and "two only"

Most Upper German orders keep the feast and the next day: "Der Ostertag sampt dem nächsten darnach" (Württemberg 1553, §12.5.3). Two orders show the difference plainly.

The pastor of Goldlauter describes his practice in his report to the visitors. **Goldlauter (Henneberg), parish order, 1566** (Sehling 2, p. 333; printed "Groldlauter"):

> Also pfleg ich es auch zu halten auf die hohe fest, wie oben stehet, one allein die lieder von einem idlichen fest werden gesungen an statt der vorigen und auf weinachten feiern wir drei tage, auf ostern und pfingsten nur zwen wie in der agend stehet.

So am I wont to keep it also on the high feasts, as standeth above, save only that the songs of each feast are sung instead of the former; and at Christmas we keep holy three days, at Easter and Whitsuntide but two, as standeth in the agenda.

**Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (§12.6.3) keeps "Der erst und ander christag. Der erst und ander ostertag … Erst und ander pfingstag": two days at each feast, and so no third day at Christmas either.

### 12.7.3 St Stephen and St John in Christmas week

In the medieval calendar 26 and 27 December were the feasts of St Stephen and St John the Evangelist, both of high grade. Luther's *Formula missae* keeps "the office of the Nativity" on those days (§12.3.1). The orders then choose among three answers:

- **They become the second and third days of Christmas**, with the Christmas Gospel and at most a mention of the saint. This is the common Lutheran solution.
- **They are kept as saints' days** within Christmas.

- **They are joined into one day**, as at Weißenburg 1528 (§12.5.7) and in one recension of Brenz's Hall order.

**Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527**, variant B (Sehling 17/1, p. 53):

> B: den Christag mitsampt Sant Stephans tag also, das man Sant Stephans und Sant Johans, nachfolgenden tag, fur ein und nit zwen feyrtag halte

B: Christmas day together with St Stephen's day, so that St Stephen's and St John's, the day following, be kept for one holy day and not two

At Wolfenbüttel the saints are joined to the "festival sermon" of the second and third Christmas days as themes of their own. **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 62):

> Am dage Stephani neven der festpredike schal men ock prediken van den diaken edder gemeinen kastendenern, darby antheen dat exempel Stephani und Laurentii, darmit den lüden ein sorchfeldicheit ingebildet werde vor de armen. Am dage Johannis des evangelisten is tho reden neven der festpredike van dem berope edder eschinge eines jeweliken mynschen.

On St Stephen's day, beside the festival sermon, one shall also preach of the deacons or common chest-servants, and allege thereby the example of Stephen and Laurence, that a carefulness for the poor may be imprinted on the people. On the day of John the Evangelist one is to speak, beside the festival sermon, of the calling or vocation of every man.

**Note.**

- **Grubenhagen 1544** adds the Holy Innocents on 28 December as a fourth day of Christmas, kept "while the sermon lasteth" (§12.5.5).
- **Braunschweig 1528** tells the preacher to remember St John after the sermon of the third day of Christmas, and St Stephen after the sermon of the second (p. 398).

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## 12.8 Individual feasts and where they stand

### 12.8.1 Purification and Annunciation: Marian names, feasts of Christ

Following Luther ("Festum purificationis et annunciationis pro festis Christi … habemus", §12.3.1), almost every order keeps these two days and counts them among the feasts of Christ. The orders often rename them to make the point:

- "Der tag der offenbarung Christi in dem tempel, so man nennet purificationis Mariae" (Saxony 1539, §12.5.2).
- "Der tag der opferung Christi im tempel" (Mecklenburg 1552, §12.5.2).
- "Annunciationis Mariae oder conceptionis Christi" (Mecklenburg 1552, Sayn 1582 and others).
- "Purificationis Christi et Marie. Annunciacionis Christi" (Hausmann, Anhalt 1532, §12.5.7).

Their rank is still not fixed:

- **Whole holy days**: in Mecklenburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561, Mansfeld 1580 and Brieg 1592.
- **Half days**: in Landau 1562 and Ysenburg 1582 (§12.6.2).
- **Forenoon only**: in Württemberg 1536 (§12.5.3).

When the Annunciation falls in Holy Week it has to be moved, and the orders' rules for this show how its rank was understood (§12.14.2).

### 12.8.2 The Visitation

The Visitation (2 July) was a late-medieval feast, but its Gospel (Luke 1:39–56, with the *Magnificat*) made it acceptable. Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) already keeps it (§12.3.2). Riga 1530 keeps it "because that was the first revelation of Christ, when he was yet in his mother's womb" (§12.3.7). Saxony 1539 keeps it "because of that history of the Gospel" (§12.5.2).

It usually stands in the second rank, beside John the Baptist and Michaelmas. In the Nürnberg family its date was moved to 15 August, to take the place of the Assumption and to spare the harvest (§12.6.4).

### 12.8.3 The Assumption: abolished, replaced, or kept "for the working peasants"

No feast shows the range of the orders better than the Assumption (15 August). It has no Gospel history. But in north Germany it was one of the four feasts on which the "four-times" offering was paid (§12.9), and elsewhere it was a harvest holiday. The orders deal with it in three ways.

**1. Kept, but preached as the Visitation.**

**Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 204):

> Unser Frauen tag irer himelfart, nit darumb das der in der heiligen schrift grund hab, sunder von des gemainen arbeitenden pauersvolks wegen. Doch soll an solichem fest in den kirchen die historien von unser frauen fest Visitationis genant, derhalben man in dem heiligen evangelio zeugnus hat, mit singen und lesen gehalten werden

Our Lady's day of her Ascension, not because it hath ground in holy Scripture, but for the sake of the common labouring country-folk. Yet on that feast the history of our Lady's feast called the Visitation, whereof there is witness in the holy Gospel, shall be kept in the churches with singing and reading

Tecklenburg has the same text in Low German, and there the day also counts as one of the four chief feasts. **Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 22, p. 245):

> Unser leven frouwen hemelvaertdes dag, assumptionis genant, alß ein veerhochtydsfeest, nicht darom, dat et in der hilligen schrift grundt hebbe, […] sonder von des gemeinen arbeidenden werckvolcks wegen; doch sol an solchen fest in der kercken de historia visitationis Mariae, der men in dem evangelio tuighniße hefft, mit singen und lesen geholden werden.

Our dear Lady's Ascension day, called the Assumption, as a feast of the four high times; not that it hath ground in the holy Scripture, […] but for the sake of the common labouring work-folk; yet on that feast the history of the Visitation of Mary, whereof there is witness in the Gospel, shall be kept in the church with singing and reading.

**Note.** The Stift Osnabrück order of 1543 (Sehling 7/1, p. 223) forbids the feast outright. Its editor notes that some territories kept it as a *Vierzeitenfest* on the Nürnberg model. Veit Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* of 1545 moves the Visitation itself to 15 August (§12.6.4).

**2. Abolished, and Michaelmas made the fourth chief feast in its place.** This is the northern solution: Mecklenburg 1552 (§12.5.2), Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (§12.5.5), Lippe 1571 and Oldenburg 1573 (§12.9). The Mecklenburg visitors of 1557 insisted on it.

**Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 1557** (Sehling 5, p. 224):

> Auch wirt angezeigt, wie es mit den festen oder feiertagen hinfurder uber das jar eintregtiglich soll gehalten werden, nemlich das uber die fest Cristi allein der apostel tage sollen gefiert werden, wie in der kirchenordenung nach der leng ausgedruckt und insonderheit das man das fest Assumptionis Marie hinfurder nicht halten noch dulden will, sondern den tag Michaelis an desselben stadt ein vierzeiten fest sein soll.

It is also shewed how it shall be kept henceforth with one accord through the year with the feasts or holy days: namely that, beside the feasts of Christ, only the apostles' days shall be kept holy, as is set out at length in the church order; and in especial that the feast of the Assumption of Mary shall henceforth be neither kept nor suffered, but that the day of Michael shall be a feast of the four times in its stead.

**3. Simply kept.** A number of orders keep the Assumption as a holy day:

- the conservative lists of Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hausmann 1532 and Weißenburg 1528 (§12.5.7);
- Nassau-Dillenburg 1537, among the harvest feasts moved to Sunday (§12.6.4);
- the Danish-Holstein order of 1542, "Festa Ascensionis" (§12.5.4).

### 12.8.4 The other Marian feasts

The Conception (8 December), Nativity (8 September) and Presentation (21 November) of Mary have no Gospel history. Most orders drop them in silence. A few name them in order to abolish them, among them Sayn 1582, "Sonderlich aber festum conceptionis, nativitatis, praesentationis, assumptionis Mariae", and Regensburg 1567 (§12.3.7). A few keep one or more:

| Order | Treatment |
|---|---|
| Anhalt, Hausmann, 1532 (§12.5.7) | "Visitacionis, conceptionis Marie", Assumption and Nativity all kept |
| Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 (Sehling 10, pp. 74–75) | Assumption and "Mariae geburt, nativitatis genant" kept |
| Brandenburg 1540 (§12.5.7) | Assumption and Nativity kept |
| Wied 1564 (Reformed; §12.4.5) | Nativity of Mary a sermon day ("tantum fiet concio") |
| Anhalt 1568 (§12.4.5) | Visitation and Nativity of Mary kept *ferialiter*, with their Gospels, not as holy days |
| Teschen 1584 (§12.5.7) | "Mariae gebuert" among the holy days |

### 12.8.5 Michaelmas: the angels and the harvest

Michaelmas (29 September) rises highest of all the saints' days. Most orders give the day three themes, as Saxony 1539 does: "daran von den heiligen engeln zu predigen":

- the doctrine of the holy angels;
- thanksgiving for the harvest;
- in the north, the fourth payment of the four-times offering (§12.9).

**Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 95):

> De dach Michaelis ys eine gemene danckseggínge vor alle fruchte, de wy des Jars gesamlet und entfangen hebben. Darumme schal de gantze vorsamlinge vorth na der predigen singen tho der danckseggínge mit groter andacht: Te Deum Laudamus etc. Averst den gantzen dach aver, so wol des morges alse des namiddages, schal men Predigen van den Engeln, up dat yderman vorsta, wat gudes wy van Gade dorch eren denst entfangen hebben, dat wy ock Gade darvor dancken mögen.

The day of Michael is a common thanksgiving for all fruits which we have gathered and received in the year. Therefore the whole congregation shall straightway after the sermon sing for the thanksgiving, with great devotion, *Te Deum laudamus*, etc. But the whole day through, as well in the morning as in the afternoon, one shall preach of the angels, that every man may understand what good we have received from God through their service, that we also may thank God therefor.

In Braunschweig the *Te Deum* is sung before the Gospel. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 397):

> Denne schal eyn predicante, wen de epistole gelesen is, vor deme evangelio vormanen dat volk, Gade to danken vor alle woldät unde besondergen vor de früchte disses jares, de he uns gegeven hefft intosamelen […] schal he singen laten Te Deum etc., ehr me dat evangelion lest.

Then shall a preacher, when the epistle is read, before the Gospel, exhort the people to thank God for all benefits, and especially for the fruits of this year which he hath given us to gather in […] he shall let *Te Deum* be sung, etc., before the Gospel is read.

**Note.** Michaelmas's rank still varies from place to place:

- **A chief feast**: the fourth *Vierzeitenfest* in Braunschweig, Hamburg, Lübeck, Grubenhagen, Mecklenburg, Hoya, Lippe, Oldenburg and Waldeck.
- **Preached "before and after noon"**: in Mecklenburg, where it formally stands in the second rank.
- **A whole day with Te Deum**: in the Brunswick orders.
- **A half day**: in Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1561 (§12.6.2) and Nassau-Weilburg 1609.
- **A sermon day only**: in Wied 1564 (Reformed; §12.4.5).
- **A "small feast", though with three sermons**: in Danzig 1612 (§12.5.6).

### 12.8.6 John the Baptist

The Nativity of John the Baptist (24 June) is kept by nearly every order, usually in the second rank. The reason given is either the Gospel history of his birth or the office of preaching: "zu ehren dem heiligen predigampt des evangelii von Christo" (Saxony 1539, Merseburg 1544). The Pomeranian order of 1535 counts him with the feasts of Christ: "dat fest hört ock up Christum" (§12.5.4). The Wolfenbüttel order of 1543 gives his day a polemical theme.

**Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 62–63):

> Am dage Johannis Baptistae schal men prediken van dem uthwendigen denste des göttliken wordes wedder de wedderdöpere, welcke […] up dem sproke stan: Se werden alle van Gade geleret werden. Darmede se alle scholen wüste maken.

On the day of John the Baptist one shall preach of the outward ministry of the divine Word against the Anabaptists, who […] stand upon the saying, They shall be all taught of God; wherewith they would lay all the schools waste.

### 12.8.7 Trinity

The feast of the Trinity falls on a Sunday. It is usually listed at the end of the feasts of Christ with the note that it "gefellet auf den nehesten sontag nach pfingsten" (Saxony 1539, Mecklenburg 1552). Its rank is shown in four ways:

- **The Kyrie.** It shares the *Kyrie summum* with Pentecost at Nördlingen and Buxtehude (§12.4.2).
- **The Latin Mass.** It is one of the "Hogen Festen Christi" with a Latin Mass in Schleswig-Holstein 1542 (§12.10.1).
- **The Athanasian Creed.** It is read on the day and its vigil in the Thüngen lessons of 1587.
- **Solemnity.** It is kept "hochfeyerlich" in Verden 1606.

The Brandenburg-Ansbach chapter order of 1533 notes only that its office "ist rain" (§12.4.4).

### 12.8.8 Mary Magdalene, the Conversion of Paul, the Beheading of John: kept for their Gospels

Three days that are not apostles' days are often ranked with them, because they have a story in the New Testament. These are the Conversion of Paul (25 January), Mary Magdalene (22 July, Luke 7:36–50) and the Beheading of John the Baptist (29 August). Where they are not holy days, the orders keep their Gospels on the nearest weekday or Sunday.

**Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 201):

> Wenn solche heilige tage gefallen, die man nicht pfleget zu feiren, und doch ire historien im evangelio beschrieben sind, als da ist der tag Conversionis Pauli, Marie Magdalene, S. Johannis entheubtung etc. mögen die prediger den selben text und historien an einem solchen werktage, nemlich, mitwoch oder freitage, der solchem heiligen tag am nehesten ist, in der predigt lesen und handlen.

When such holy days fall as are not wont to be kept holy, and yet their histories are written in the Gospel, as is the day of the Conversion of Paul, Mary Magdalene, St John's beheading, etc., the preachers may read and handle the same text and histories in the sermon on such working day, namely Wednesday or Friday, as is next to such holy day.

Solms-Laubach gives a reason for keeping the Beheading of John. **Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 9, p. 356):

> Der tag Johannis enthauptung oder [decollatio Johannis] mag uf ein gemeinen wochenpredigttag (dieweil derselb eine herliche histori und zeugnus hat, wie die weldt frommen predigern pflegt zulohnen) verlegt werden, wie dan auch das evan[…]gelium von Marien Magdalenen, dieweil es eine nutzliche und tröstliche historiam inhelt.

The day of John's beheading may be laid on a common week-day sermon day (since the same hath a glorious history and witness how the world is wont to reward godly preachers), as also the Gospel of Mary Magdalene, since it containeth a profitable and comfortable history.

In Prussia Mary Magdalene's Gospel is given a fixed Sunday. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 87):

> Das evangelium Mariä Magdalenä Luc. 7 soll ordinarie und hinfort jährlich Dominica septima nach Trinitatis gelesen und gepredigt werden

The Gospel of Mary Magdalene, Luke 7, shall ordinarily and henceforth yearly be read and preached on the seventh Sunday after Trinity

#### 12.8.9 Corpus Christi, the Holy Cross, local and new feasts

**Corpus Christi.** Most orders abolish it, and some order it to be explained so that people will know why it has gone.

**Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1096):

> Das fest corporis Christi sol vermüge Gottes worts abgetan sein und sollen die prediger den Sontag zuvor das volk erinnern, was für ein grosser misbrauch und abgötterey damit getrieben worden, deren sich ein jeder Christ nach dem ernstlichen befehl Gottes enthalten sol.

The feast of Corpus Christi shall be done away according to God's Word, and the preachers shall on the Sunday before remind the people what great abuse and idolatry hath been practised therewith, which every Christian ought to shun according to the earnest commandment of God.

Two early orders keep it: Northeim for civic reasons, and Nassau-Dillenburg to teach the right use of the Sacrament.

**Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 6/2, p. 935):

> Des Herrn waren leichnams tag hat man umb sonderlicher politischer, das ist bürgerlicher ursach willen müssen bleiben lassen. Aber doch also, das die processio sampt allen andern unchristlichen ceremonien abgeschafft und allein Gottes wort und das nachtmal des Herrn zu handeln und halten gestatet werden sol.

The day of the Lord's true Body men have had to let stand for special political, that is, civil causes; yet so that the procession, with all other unchristian ceremonies, be done away, and only God's Word and the Lord's Supper be suffered to be handled and held thereon.

**Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 74):

> Unnsers herren leichnams tag, corporis Christi genant, soll darumb werden behalten, das man daran von dem rechten gebrauch unnd frucht des hohen hailigen sacraments des leibs unnd bluts Christi richtig lere unnd predige. Es soll aber das sacrament weder an dem noch an keinem anndern tagk im jar außgestelt noch umbgetragen werden

Our Lord's Body day, called Corpus Christi, shall be retained to this end, that one may rightly teach and preach thereon of the right use and fruit of the high holy Sacrament of the body and blood of Christ. But the Sacrament shall be neither set out nor carried about, on that nor on any other day in the year

**The Holy Cross.** Luther's "Festa S. Crucis anathema sunto" (§12.3.1) is echoed in Sayn 1582, "die beiden creutz tage, inventionis und exaltationis crucis" (§12.5.5). No order keeps them.

**Local and civic feasts.** Some towns kept days of their own, and the orders treat them in different ways:

- **Braunschweig.** St Autor had been honoured with a civic procession under a vow. It was turned into alms and a Sunday thanksgiving (Sehling 6/1, p. 398).
- **Wied 1564** (Reformed). Patronal feasts are kept with a sermon (§12.4.5).
- **New days.** Some towns added days of their own: a day of penance for the Osnabrück fire of 1613 (§12.6.2); a thanksgiving in Nördlingen for the town's deliverance from a planned surprise attack in 1440 (Sehling 12, pp. 387–388); and in Regensburg a dedication festival in October for the beginning of evangelical preaching in 1542 (Sehling 13, p. 475).

**A new feast of Christ.** Bugenhagen proposed a feast the medieval calendar did not have.

**Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 380):

> Id is wunder, dat me nicht hefft gehat eyn fest van der döpe Christi, dewile me doch so vele unnutte feste hefft gehat, to vorderve lives unde der selen. […] Dat also de Vastelavendessundach by uns moge heten dat fest der döpe Christi, me mach id denne nömen, wo me wil.

It is a wonder that there hath been no feast of the baptism of Christ, seeing there have been so many unprofitable feasts, to the destruction of body and soul. […] So that the Shrovetide Sunday may with us be called the feast of the baptism of Christ; one may then name it as one will.

**Note.** Wolfenbüttel 1543 keeps this "feast of the baptism" on the Sunday before Lent, with the Gospel of Matthew 3 preached "den ganzen dach över", all day long (Sehling 6/1, p. 62).

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## 12.9 The *Vierzeiten*: the four chief feasts and the four offerings

In north and central Germany the highest rank of feasts had a name that came from church finance, not liturgy. These were the *vier Zeiten* (Low German *veer tide*), or the four *Hochzeiten*. They were the four feasts on which the "four-times penny" (*Vierzeitenpfennig*, *veertide pennink*) or offering was paid to the pastor or the church chest. Three of the four were fixed: Christmas, Easter and Whitsuntide. The fourth varied by region, as the editors' notes show. It was most often the Assumption (so at Minden, Sehling 21, p. 138). The Bergedorf order names St John the Baptist's day instead (Sehling 5, p. 389, cited by the Buxtehude editor, Sehling 7/1, p. 79). At St John's in Halberstadt the penny was collected quarterly, on John the Baptist's day, Michaelmas, and the Tuesdays of Christmas and Easter (Sehling 2, p. 488).

The Lutheran orders kept the payment, and with it the rank. Most of them replaced the Assumption with Michaelmas, which fell in the same season (after the harvest) and had a lawful Gospel theme (the angels). The *Vierzeiten* are the Lutheran north's equivalent of the *summa festa*. A *Vierzeitenfest* is a whole holy day, often with first vespers and a sermon on the eve, and with a Latin Mass.

### 12.9.1 The four times named

Bugenhagen's Lübeck order describes the treasure-chest. **Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1531** (Sehling 5, p. 362):

> In desse caste schal kamen de veer tide pennink ut allen caspelen. De veer tide sint: paschen, pinxten, michaelis, winachten. Denne schal ein grot becken stan in allen kerken up dem altare vor dem chore. Twe kerkvedere schölen dar acht up hebben und nicht verne dar van sin , und alle lüde van twelf iaren und dar baven iunk und olt, schölen dar bringen den tide pennink.

Into this chest shall come the four-times penny out of all the parishes. The four times are Easter, Whitsuntide, Michaelmas, Christmas. Then shall a great basin stand in all churches on the altar before the choir. Two churchwardens shall have an eye thereon and not be far from it; and all folk of twelve years and above, young and old, shall bring thither the times-penny.

A pre-Reformation police ordinance of Waldeck names the four *Hochzeiten* first among the days on which attendance at Mass is enforced. **Waldeck, *Landordnung*, 1525** (Sehling 9, p. 179):

> Auch setzen, ordiniren und wollen wir, ernstlich gebietthende, das ein ider unßer undersaße, so zu seinen mundigen jharen khommen, uff die vier hochzeittliche feste und sonntage, auch uff alle unßer lieben frawen- und apostelltage in seiner pfarkirchen das ampt der heiligen meß und das heilige evangelium von ihrem pfarherrn heeren sollen

We also set, ordain and will, earnestly commanding, that every one of our subjects that is come to his years of discretion shall, on the four high-tide feasts and Sundays, and also on all our Lady's and apostles' days, hear in his parish church the office of the holy mass and the holy Gospel from their parson

The Pomeranian order sets out the due itself. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 414):

> De veertiden pennink, alle quartal van jeder person bauen 12. jar, ein veerken, schal gegeven werden, entweder dem pastori edder der kercken, wo idt jeders ordes gebrücklick.

The four-times penny, every quarter, from every person above twelve years, a farthing, shall be given either to the pastor or to the church, as is the custom in every place.

The same dues are found in the lower Rhineland, in the Erasmian Catholic order of Jülich-Cleves, where they are called the "four high-tide offerings". **Jülich-Cleves-Berg, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1559** (Roman Catholic humanist; Sehling 21, p. 87):

> yedoch das einem yeden die vier hochzeitoffer unnd -broder, wie hiebevor verordent, gegeben werden

yet so that to every one the four high-tide offerings and loaves be given, as heretofore ordained

### 12.9.2 Michaelmas in the Assumption's place

The replacement was made by Braunschweig 1528 ("Item Michaelis vor eyn vehrtidenvest", §12.5.4) and Hamburg 1529. It became standard through Mecklenburg 1552 (§12.5.2) and the visitation of 1557 (§12.8.3). The later orders write it into their feast lists.

**Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, pp. 391–392):

> Der tag Michaelis, welcher an statt des Festes Assumptionis Mariae in unsern Kirchen als ein viergezeiten Fest feirlich gehalten […] und darauff die notwendige tröstliche Lere von den lieben heiligen Engeln der Gemeine Gottes fürgetragen und gehandelt wirdt. Auff diesen Festen sol es mit Ordnung der Lectionen, Gesengen, Predigten und Communion gehalten werden wie an den gemeinen Sontagen, Allein, das die Introitus, Sequentz und auff den Viergezeiten Festagen die Praefationes de tempore, Item die Teutsche Alte Festliedlein, wie oben ermelt und bey uns gewöntlich, gesungen werden.

The day of Michael, which in the stead of the feast of the Assumption of Mary is kept solemnly in our churches as a feast of the four times […] and whereon the needful comfortable doctrine of the dear holy angels is set forth and handled to the congregation of God. On these feasts it shall be done, as touching the order of the lessons, chants, sermons and communion, as on the common Sundays; only that the introits and sequences, and on the four-times feast days the prefaces *de tempore*, item the old German feast-songs, as above mentioned and customary with us, be sung.

**Note.** Lippe ranks the *Vierzeiten* above the other feasts of Christ by one liturgical mark, the proper preface. The same order calls them "die herrliche, schöne, heilige, fürnembste viergezeiten Fest", the glorious, fair, holy, chiefest four-times feasts (p. 392).

**Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097):

> Der tag Michaelis, welcher anstadt des fests […] assumtionis oder himelfart Mariae als ein viergezeitenfest gehalten, an welchem die lere von den heiligen engeln dem volk sol fürgehalten werden. Desgleichen sol auch an demselbigen fest nach verlesener epistel ein gemeine danksagung geschehen für die empfangene früchten und darzu das Te Deum laudamus gesungen werden.

The day of Michael, which is kept as a feast of the four times in the stead of the feast […] of the Assumption or Ascension of Mary, whereon the doctrine of the holy angels shall be set forth to the people. Likewise also on the same feast, after the epistle is read, a common thanksgiving shall be made for the fruits received, and the *Te Deum laudamus* be sung thereto.

In the Harlingerland order the payment is the reason given for Michaelmas taking the place. **Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74** (Sehling 7/1, p. 735):

> Ordnen derohalben, daß der [!] letzste und vierte hochfesttagzeit solle S. Michaelis tag sein. Und sollen die kaspelßleute dem pastorn am selben tag öhre opfer, gebuhrlichen pflicht und landheur guedtlichen entrichten und ohne hinderung dorgeben und bezahlen.

We ordain therefore that the last and fourth high feast-tide shall be St Michael's day. And the parishioners shall on the same day render kindly to the pastor their offering, due duty and land-rent, and give and pay it without hindrance.

### 12.9.3 The *Vierzeiten* as a liturgical rank

At Wolfenbüttel a sermon at first vespers is allowed only on the four. The same words stand in Hildesheim 1544 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 858). **Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 6/1, p. 62):

> In den grösten festen edder veer tyden: Wynachten, Paschen, Pinxsten und Michaelis mach men thor ersten vesper eine stunde prediken. In den andern festen is dat nicht van nöden.

On the greatest feasts, or four times, Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas, one may preach for an hour at the first vespers. On the other feasts it is not needful.

Hoya has the Mass in Latin throughout. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1151):

> VI. Von den vierzeitenfesten. Auf den vierzeitenfesten sol man das meßampt in unsern kirchen, da man es haben kan, durchaus latine, mit dem introitu, Kyrie eleyson, gloria in excelsis, collecten, episteln, sequentien, evangelien etc. halten, doch das die gewönlichen deudsche psalm, welche auf die fest verordnet (damit auch die kirche singe), nicht vergessen werden.

VI. Of the four-times feasts. On the four-times feasts one shall hold the office of the mass in our churches, where it can be had, throughout in Latin, with the introit, Kyrie eleison, *Gloria in excelsis*, collects, epistles, sequences, Gospels, etc.; yet so that the wonted German psalms which are appointed for the feasts (that the church also may sing) be not forgotten.

In Lauenburg the *hohe Vierzeitenfeste* are the days for the alms collection, and the meal the pastor used to give the churchwardens on those days is abolished. **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 421):

> Zum vierzehenden sollen sie alle sontage und auf den feiertagen und hohen vierzeiten festen die bete von den leuten unter der predigt fleissig samlen, aufschreiben und beilegen […] Und letzlich sol genzlich abgeschaffet sein auf den hohen vierzeiten festen die collation und frass, welchen der pastor bis daher den kirchgeschworen auf solchen festen hat geben müssen.

Fourteenthly, they shall on all Sundays, and on the holy days and the high four-times feasts, diligently gather the collection from the people during the sermon, write it down and lay it by […] And lastly there shall be wholly done away on the high four-times feasts the collation and feasting which the pastor hath hitherto had to give the churchwardens on such feasts.

In the Neumark the churchwardens are to take the collection plate round on the high feasts generally, not only on the four. **Neumark (Brandenburg), instruction of Margrave Johann for the visitors, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 36):

> Dieselben gottesleute sollen auch alle hohe feier feste, nicht allein die vier zeiten mit der tafel umbgehen in der kirchen

The same churchwardens shall also go about in the church with the plate on all high holy feasts, not only on the four times

**Note.** Grubenhagen 1544 defines its first rank of feasts by this payment ("die vier hauptfest, an welchen man den vierzeitpenning sammelt", §12.5.5). Henneberg 1582 has four chief feasts, but they are Christmas, Easter, Ascension and Whitsuntide (§12.6.3). It shows that "four chief feasts" could be understood liturgically as well as fiscally.

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## 12.10 Keeping the feast in church: ceremonial marks, abolished ceremonies and the seasons

Beyond whole and half holy days, the orders mark the higher feasts with a set of ceremonial additions. None of them is new. Each carries on, in reduced form, a feature of the medieval feast grades. Listed from the commonest to the rarest:

| Mark | Higher feasts | Lower feasts and ordinary days | Examples |
|---|---|---|---|
| Sermons | two or three, sometimes four; a sermon at first vespers | one sermon, in the forenoon | §12.6.3; Wolfenbüttel 1543 (§12.9.3); Danzig (§12.5.6) |
| Latin chant | introit, *Gloria*, Alleluia, sequence, *Patrem*, preface, Sanctus, *Agnus Dei* in Latin | German hymns | §12.10.1 |
| Kyrie grade | *summum*, *paschale*, *festivale* | *dominicale*, *angelicum*, *apostolicum*, *feriale* | §12.4.2, §12.10.2 |
| Proper preface | preface of the feast (*de tempore*, *solemnis*) | common preface, exhortation, or none | §12.10.3 |
| Sequence | kept on the great feasts | dropped | §12.10.4 |

| Mark | Higher feasts | Lower feasts and ordinary days | Examples |
|---|---|---|---|
| Figural music and organ | figural music, organ | plain-song or German; no organ | §12.10.5 |
| Vestments, elevation | mass vestment, elevation | choir robe or none | §12.10.6 |
| Bells | more bells, chiming (*beiern*) the day before | one bell | §12.10.7 |
| Creed and *Te Deum* | *Athanasianum*, Latin *Te Deum* | — | §12.10.8 |
| Communion | communion and first vespers with confession | no communion on apostles' days | §12.10.9 |
| Civil marks | no weddings, markets or guild feasts | — | §12.11.3 |

### 12.10.1 Latin chant on the high feasts

The Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528 set the pattern. Latin is kept for the higher feasts "because it is unseemly always to sing one song".

**Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, pp. 165 and 169):

> An hohen festen, als christag, ostern, auffart, pfingsten, oder der gleichen, were gut, das zur messe etliche lateinische gesenge, die der schrift gemes, gebrauchet würden. Denn es ist ein ungestalt, imerdar ein gesang singen. […] Mit den festen sol es auch fridlich gehalten werden, also, das wo etliche schlechte feier abgangen sind, das man davon nicht viel zanks mache. Dieweil es auch ein ungestalt ist, das die gesang gar gleich sind an allen festen, were gut, das man an den herrlichsten festen sünge, die lateinische introitus, gloria in excelsis deo, halleluia, die reinen sequenz, sanctus, agnus dei.

On high feasts, as Christmas, Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, or the like, it were good that certain Latin chants, agreeable to Scripture, were used at the mass. For it is an unseemly thing evermore to sing one song. […] With the feasts also it shall be done peaceably: that where certain plain holy days have fallen away, men make not much strife thereof. And forasmuch as it is also unseemly that the chants be all alike on all feasts, it were good that on the most glorious feasts there were sung the Latin introits, *Gloria in excelsis Deo*, Alleluia, the pure sequences, Sanctus, *Agnus Dei*.

In Ernestine Saxony the rule depends on the place as well as the day. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Gemeine Verordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 192):

> In steten und flecken da knabenschulen und leut sind, die lateinisch versteen, mag man an hohen festen lateinisch, sonst deutsch mess halten, auf den dorfern aber do niemands lateinisch versteet, soll man durch aus deutsch mess halten […] Zu merken, wen man gleich an hohen festen die mess lateinisch heldet, so liset man dennoch die epistel, das evangelion, die wort des sacraments, das vater unser alles deutsch und laut

In towns and market towns, where there are boys' schools and folk that understand Latin, one may hold mass in Latin on high feasts, otherwise in German; but in the villages, where no man understandeth Latin, one shall hold mass in German throughout […] Note: even when mass is held in Latin on high feasts, yet the epistle, the Gospel, the words of the Sacrament and the Lord's Prayer are all read in German and aloud

In Schleswig-Holstein the high feasts are named, and Trinity is one of them. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 91):

> In den Hogen Festen Christi, alse dar sint Winachten, Paschen, Pingesten und Trinitatis, schal men yn den steden singen up latin de Introitus, Gloria yn Excelsis, Alleluia mit reinen sequentien, Item latinische prefatien, Welcker de Prester also anhevet: Dominus vobiscum etc., Sursum Corda etc., Darna Sanctus, thom lesten Pater noster Mit den wörden des Avendmals, doch de stedes yn düdescher sprake

On the high feasts of Christ, which are Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Trinity, one shall sing in the towns in Latin the introits, *Gloria in excelsis*, Alleluia with pure sequences; item Latin prefaces, which the priest beginneth thus: *Dominus vobiscum*, etc., *Sursum corda*, etc.; thereafter the Sanctus; lastly the *Pater noster* with the words of the Supper, yet these always in the German tongue

At Buxtehude the *Gloria* follows the rank. **Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 7/1, p. 74):

> Volgende schall gesungen werden dat Kyrie eleison na gelegenheit, Gloria in excelsis unde dat [Et] in terra, in den hogen festen stedes lattinisch, upp den Sondagen und sunst dudesch edder latinisch, wo idt de tydt liden will.

Next shall be sung the Kyrie eleison as occasion serveth, *Gloria in excelsis* and the *Et in terra*: on the high feasts always in Latin, on the Sundays and otherwise in German or in Latin, as the time will allow.

Thorn has the reverse rule. On Sundays the chants before the sermon are in Latin, but the small feasts are wholly German. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 238):

> Sonsten die gesänge, collecten und lectiones für der predigt werden alles lateinisch gehalten. An den aposteltagen und anderen kleinen festen, die man mit halber feier zu halten pfleget, wird das ganze officium deutsch gehalten, beide in der alten und neuenstadt

Otherwise the chants, collects and lessons before the sermon are all held in Latin. On the apostles' days and other small feasts, which are wont to be kept with half solemnity, the whole office is held in German, both in the Old and the New Town

### 12.10.2 Chant on the apostles' days

The lower feasts have their own marks in several orders. They are enough to set them off from working days without matching Sundays.

The Pomeranian *Agenda* gives the rule for the apostles' days. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 469):

> Dise navolgenden aposteldage schal men viren vor middage. Des sondages to vörne schölen se de prediger affkündigen, jederman vormanen, dat he an disen dagen tor kercke kame, des avendes to vörne schal men festivaliter lüden edder beieren, unde vesper holden, des morgens desgeliken festivaliter lüden, to 7. edder to 8. predigen, jedoch neen testament utdele, doch mach men vor dem sermone dat amt vor dem altare holden, gloria, collecta, epistel unde evangelium cum tono lesen, up dat tüschen disen dagen unde gemenen werkeldagen underscheed si. Wennt in der kercke ut is, geit ein jeder to siner arbeit.

These following apostles' days one shall keep holy before noon. On the Sunday before, the preachers shall bid them and exhort every man to come to church on these days. On the evening before one shall ring or chime *festivaliter*, and hold vespers; in the morning likewise ring *festivaliter*, preach at seven or eight, yet deal out no testament [no communion]; but one may hold the office before the altar before the sermon, read the *Gloria*, collect, epistle and Gospel with the tone, that there may be a difference between these days and the common working days. When church is out, every man goeth to his work.

The Aschersleben agenda sets out the apostles' day Mass and vespers. **Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 480):

> Von der vesper an der apostel abend. Die vesper soll gehalten werden wie am sonnabende, doch das man de festo singe und auch die collecten de festo lese. Von der messe an der apostel tage. 1. Nach dem geleute, welches geschehen soll, wie an einem werkeltage, hebt der cantor alspalt mit dem introitu an. 2. Darauf folget das kyrie apostolicum. 3. Nochmals wird das teutsche „Allein gott in der höhe“ etc. gesungen. 4. Collecta de festo apostoli, darauf die epistel gelesen. […] Von der vesper an der apostel tage. Die vesper wird gesungen ohne den organisten wie sonsten am werktage, dieweil keine predigt gehalten.

Of vespers on the apostle's eve. Vespers shall be held as on the Saturday, yet so that one sing *de festo* and read the collects *de festo* also. Of the mass on the apostles' days. 1. After the ringing, which shall be done as on a working day, the cantor straightway beginneth the introit. 2. Thereupon followeth the *Kyrie apostolicum*. 3. Then is sung the German "Allein Gott in der Höh", etc. 4. The collect of the feast of the apostle, and thereafter the epistle is read. […] Of vespers on the apostles' days. Vespers are sung without the organist, as otherwise on a working day, since no sermon is held.

The Riga order gives the melody of the Kyrie. **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 15):

> Auf den introit, singt man das kyrie eleison, mit wenig noten (ausgenommen auf die hohen fest, da man notam paschalem nemen mag)

After the introit one singeth the Kyrie eleison with few notes (save on the high feasts, when one may take the paschal note)

### 12.10.3 Proper prefaces

Proper prefaces belonged only to the great feasts, and the orders use them to mark those days.

The same text is in Hamburg 1529 (Sehling 5, p. 528). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 441):

> Darnä keret he sick tome altare unde in den groten festen, de sunderge prefatien hebben, unde sus, wen he wil, up etlike Sundage mit der prefatie trinitatis (de wedder de Arrhianer alse ock dat symbolum nicenum gemaket is), schal he anheven latinisch de prefatie Dominus vobiscum unde singen se bet an dat ende, darup singe dat chör eyn latinisch Sanctus.

Thereafter he turneth him to the altar, and on the great feasts which have special prefaces, and else, when he will, on certain Sundays with the preface of the Trinity (which was made against the Arians, as was the Nicene Creed also), he shall begin in Latin the preface *Dominus vobiscum* and sing it to the end; whereupon let the choir sing a Latin Sanctus.

In Ottheinrich's order the preface itself has two grades. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, second printing 1547** (Sehling 14, p. 109):

> Es seind aber auf etliche hohe fest, Osterfest, Auffart, Pfingsten, Trinitatis etc., besondere prefation, von idem fest zwo, ein solemnis und eine dominicalis, die mag ein priester außnotiren oder außschreiben und auf dem pult alwegen neben der kirchenordnung haben

But for certain high feasts, the feast of Easter, the Ascension, Whitsuntide, Trinity, etc., there are special prefaces, two for each feast, a *solemnis* and a *dominicalis*; these a priest may note out or write out, and have always on the desk beside the church order

**Note.** The *solemnis* and *dominicalis* tones of the preface are the melodic grades of the medieval preface: the festal tone for the feast itself, the ferial or Sunday tone for the days within its season. The order prints the Trinity preface as its example.

At Hatzkerode there is an exhortation on ordinary days and the preface on the great feasts. **Hatzkerode (Harzgerode, Anhalt), *Kirchenordnunge*, 1534(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 587):

> Als dan sol sich der priester umb keren und die exhortatio, wie die in der agende stehet, inen vorlesen. Auf den grossen festen aber sol an des stat die prefatio de festo gesungen werden mit dem gewonlichen sanctus latinisch.

Then shall the priest turn him about and read unto them the exhortation, as it standeth in the agenda. But on the great feasts, in the stead thereof, the preface of the feast shall be sung, with the wonted Sanctus in Latin.

**Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 237):

> Nach der predigt folget ein deutsch lied, darauf die priester in hohen festen die praefation de tempore auf gewöhnliche noten singen, aber in gemeinen sonntagen und feiertagen ohne dieselbige bald nach dem deutschen gesange sich gegen dem volke wendet

After the sermon followeth a German hymn; thereupon the priests on high feasts sing the preface *de tempore* to the wonted notes; but on the common Sundays and holy days [the priest], without the same, turneth to the people straightway after the German hymn

Kurland allows German proper prefaces for the high feasts, "for variety". **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 89):

> Dar man aber auf die hohe fest zur verendrung (wie an dem fürstlichen hofe geschicht) diese nachverzeichnete und notirte praefationes für die quotidian singen wil, sol einem jedern kirchendiener frei sein

But where one will sing on the high feasts, for a change (as is done at the prince's court), these prefaces hereafter set down and noted, instead of the daily one, it shall be free to every minister

**Note.** Saxony 1539 prints Latin prefaces for Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Pentecost and Trinity, and a *Praefatio quotidiana* for all other days (Sehling 1, p. 274, editor's summary). The Mecklenburg family allows "prefationes de tempore" on the feasts of Christ (§12.5.2). Lippe 1571 restricts them to the *Vierzeiten* (§12.9.2).

#### 12.10.4 Sequences

In Schleswig-Holstein sequences are dropped except on the three great feasts, and each great feast keeps its own sequence. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 90):

> De Sequentien unde prosen scholen alle underlaten unde nicht gesungen werden, uthgenamen yn dren groten Festen Christi, alse van Wynachten wente tho Lichtmissen: Grates nunc omnes, mit synem düdeschen gesange, Van Pa[…]sehen wente tho Pingesten: Victime Paschali, mit synem düdeschen gesange, Den yn den Pingesten: Veni, Sancte Spiritus, mit synem düdeschen gesange.

The sequences and proses shall all be left off and not be sung, save on the three great feasts of Christ: as from Christmas unto Candlemas, *Grates nunc omnes*, with its German song; from Easter unto Whitsuntide, *Victimae paschali*, with its German song; then in Whitsuntide, *Veni, Sancte Spiritus*, with its German song.

**Note.**

- **Seasons, not days.** The sequence is kept through the whole season of each great feast, from Christmas to Candlemas and from Easter to Whitsuntide.
- **Aschersleben 1575.** The cantor "die sontage nach diesen festen die sequentien in der kirchen singen" (p. 479).
- **The Mecklenburg family.** Sequences are "de tempore" on the feasts of Christ (§12.5.2).

#### 12.10.5 Figural music and the organ

**Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 551):

> Ock schal de figuralgesank in den vornemblikesten festen ordentlick in einem carspel sowol als in den andern gewachtet und gesungen werden.

Also the figural song shall on the chiefest feasts be orderly observed and sung in one parish as well as in the others.

The Hof order gives the title of its collection of polyphonic music in the table of contents; the collection itself begins on p. 456. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 477):

> XVI. Ordo suavissimarum et optimarum ex prastantissimis artificibus tum veteribus tum recentibus selectarum cantionum, quae in figurali musica cantore duce decantantur ad praecipua festa totius anni directus

XVI. An order of the sweetest and best songs, chosen out of the most excellent masters both old and new, which are sung in figural music under the leading of the cantor, directed to the chief feasts of the whole year

In the Pomeranian *Agenda* there is no figural music or organ in Rogation week, except on the Ascension and its vigil. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 466):

> Up disen sondach unde in der weke schal men kenen figural sang singen, ock nicht orglen, utgenamen den dach Ascensionis domini, mit der in vigilia

On this Sunday and in the week one shall sing no figural song, nor play the organ, save the day of the Ascension of the Lord, with its vigil

**Other examples:**

- **Anhalt 1568**: figural music on the first two days of the high feasts, Latin chorale on the third (§12.7.1).
- **Regensburg 1567**: figural music at the vespers before, and the communion on, the feasts of Christ (p. 475).
- **Henneberg 1582**: lower feasts are kept "one orgeln" (§12.6.3).

- **Schwarzburg 1587**: the organ is used on the apostles' days in the forenoon (Sehling 2, p. 137).
- **Aschersleben 1575**: the vespers of apostles' days are sung "ohne den organisten" (§12.10.2).

The seasons and rites in which the organ was silent are treated in Chapter 9, §9.3.6.

#### 12.10.6 Vestments and elevation

In Prince Bernhard's Anhalt order the elevation of the Sacrament is kept only on the high feasts. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 570):

> Weil die elevation des hochwirdigen sacraments des waren leibes und blutes Christi in einer kirchen gefallen, in der andern aber nicht, so sollen die hern kirchendiener in hohen festen eleviren, ausserhalb denselben ist hochgedachter fürst Bernhart zu frieden, das es nach pleibe, desgleichen soll des sontags zu allen dreien predigten der chorrock gebraucht , die wochen uber auch nachgelassen werden.

Forasmuch as the elevation of the most worthy Sacrament of the true body and blood of Christ hath fallen away in one church but not in another, the ministers shall elevate on high feasts; beyond these the said Prince Bernhard is content that it be left off. Likewise on Sunday the choir robe shall be used at all three sermons, and through the week it may be left off.

**Note.**

- **Grimma 1529.** The mass vestment is required on the three-day high feasts (§12.7.1).
- **Querfurt.** According to Sehling's account of the visitation, mass vestments were worn at communion and, for a time, in the pulpit on the three chief feasts (Sehling 2, p. 460).

#### 12.10.7 Bells

**Altenburg, castle chapter, *Verordnung der ceremonien*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 516):

> Zum dritten, so soll man auch hinfur die unterscheid halden, das man an gemeinen werktagen mit einer grossen glocken und am sontags und andern festen mit mer glocken zum heiligen ampt der predigt zu unterscheid der zeit leüte.

Thirdly, one shall also henceforth keep this difference: that on common working days one ring to the holy office of the sermon with one great bell, and on Sundays and other feasts with more bells, to distinguish the time.

The fullest bell-code is the Danzig one of 1612 (§12.5.6). It names five bells:

- Osanna;
- Apostolica;
- Dominical;
- Ferial;
- Sybilla.

The great feasts are rung in with the great bell and the three larger bells chimed together (*beiern*). The small feasts are chimed "with the Osanna".

The bells in general, their signs and their uses, are treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.

#### 12.10.8 The Athanasian Creed and the *Te Deum*

The Mecklenburg convent order gives the rule for the convents' matins. **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572** (Sehling 5, p. 258):

> Auf die hohen feste, als weinacht, epiphania, ostern, himmelfahrt, pfingsten, trinitatis, soll nach dem benedictus also balt das symbolum Athanasii teutsch gesungen werden.

On the high feasts, as Christmas, Epiphany, Easter, Ascension, Whitsuntide and Trinity, the Athanasian Creed shall be sung in German straightway after the Benedictus.

For the *Te Deum* in Latin "in maioribus festis" see Transylvania 1547 (§12.4.3). For the *Te Deum* as the Michaelmas thanksgiving see §12.8.5.

#### 12.10.9 Communion and confession

The orders do not give the Supper by rank as such. Communion is held whenever there are communicants. But rank shows in the preparation and in the days on which communion is normally held.

- **Regensburg 1567.** Communion and vespers on the eve go with every feast of Christ, but not with the third day of the great feasts (§12.7.1).
- **Pomerania 1569.** No communion on apostles' days (§12.10.2).
- **Stade, *Kirchenordnung*, c. 1620/22** (Sehling 7/1, p. 54). On the three high feasts confession is heard after the afternoon sermon of the first day, and the Supper is given on the second day, "welches am ersten und letzten festage nicht geschicht", which is not done on the first and the last feast day.
- **First vespers.** The vespers of the eve of the higher feasts were also the time for private confession of the next day's communicants (for example Leiningen 1584, p. 278: "an den hohen festagen am abent zuvor ein vesper").

#### 12.10.10 Festal ceremonies abolished

**The plays and processions of the year.** The late-medieval feasts had their own acted ceremonies:

- the Palm Sunday ass;
- the crucifix laid in the "grave" on Good Friday;
- the image of the risen Christ carried round on Easter Day;
- the figure of Christ drawn up through the church roof on Ascension Day;
- the dove let down on Whitsunday;
- the rocking of the Christ-child's cradle at Christmas;
- processions round the church with holy water, crosses and the sacrament.

The south German orders abolish them by name. They also abolish the blessings of the year: water and salt on Sundays, candles at Candlemas, ashes on Ash Wednesday, palms on Palm Sunday, and the Easter candle, font and fire on Holy Saturday. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 77):

> Ebenmeßig sollen auch underwegen pleyben alle spectacula und schawspil, so man mit bildern getrieben hat, als am Palmentag mit dem eßel, am Karfreytag mit dem crucifix und grab, am Ostertag mit umbtragung des bilds der urstehnde Cristi, am Uffertag mit ufziehung deßelben, am Pfingstag mit herablasung der tauben, am Christag mit dem kindleinwiegen und was dergleychen mher im prauch gewesen ist. Item alle proceßion und umbgange umb die kirchen mit dem weyhewaßer und creutzen, auch mit umbtragung des heyhgen sacraments in der monstrantzen etc.

In like manner shall also be left off all spectacles and shows which have been practised with images: as on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the grave, on Easter Day with the carrying about of the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with the drawing up of the same, on Whitsunday with the letting down of the dove, on Christmas Day with the rocking of the little child, and whatever more of the like hath been in use. Item, all processions and goings about the church with holy water and crosses, and also with the carrying about of the holy sacrament in the monstrance, etc.

The same list stands in Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (Sehling 13, pp. 95–96) and the Palatine *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen* of 1546 (Sehling 14, p. 93). The Corpus Christi procession went with the feast itself (§12.8.9).

**What stayed.** What the orders keep for the feasts is the reading and preaching of the feast's history, its hymns and sequences, its proper preface, and in many places its Latin chant (§12.10.1–12.10.4). The *Leisen* sung from the pulpit at the high feasts are treated in Chapter 8 §8.10.2.

#### 12.10.11 Seasonal changes in the service

**Advent and Lent.** Some orders mark the penitential seasons by plainer chant and by leaving out the *Gloria*. The Pomeranian order of 1542 gives the old Kyrie grades by season: *dominicale* in Advent and Lent, *paschale* from Easter to Whitsun, *summum* on the higher feasts. In Lent the *Gloria* may be left out altogether. **Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 4, p. 356):

> Darup dat kyrie dominicale, efft me mach ock up die sondage, kyrie angelicum, de martiribus, effte confessoribus, efft virginibus, wo man sie genomet hefft singen, dominicale im advent und in der vasten, dat paschale tuschen pingsten und paschen, dat summum up die hohern fest, effte dat minus summum. Darup singe die priester dat gloria in excelsis [...] in der vasten mach me dat gloria wol gar ute laten, effte wenn idt will to lange werden.

Thereupon the Kyrie *dominicale*; or one may also on the Sundays sing the Kyrie *angelicum*, *de martyribus*, or *confessoribus*, or *virginibus*, as they have been named; the *dominicale* in Advent and in Lent, the *paschale* between Pentecost and Easter, the *summum* on the higher feasts, or the *minus summum*. Thereupon the priest singeth the *Gloria in excelsis* [...] in Lent one may well leave out the *Gloria* altogether, or when it will be too long.

Other seasonal changes in the orders:

- **The Creed in Advent.** At Schweinfurt "Wir glauben all" replaces "Nun bitten wir" on the three Sundays of Advent (Sehling 11, p. 646).
- **The Litany.** Days kept "plainly, *dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent" may have the Latin Litany (Pomerania, *Karcken ordening*, Sehling 4, p. 354).
- **Hymns.** The hymn tables change with the seasons: Advent, Christmas to Candlemas, Easter to Whitsun (see Chapter 8 §8.7.5 for the *Gloria* in Advent and Lent, and §8.10.3 for the seasonal hymns before the sermon).
- **Luther's warning.** Luther himself would not have Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday shown off "with other rites" than the rest of the year (§12.12.1).

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## 12.11 Keeping holy days in common life

The orders kept the calendar by law as much as by liturgy. A holy day was a day on which work, trade and amusement were restricted, and the restrictions were enforced by the magistrate. This section covers the rest from work (§12.11.1), its enforcement (§12.11.2), weddings, guild feasts and markets (§12.11.3), the folk festivals of the year (§12.11.4), and one feast created to replace them (§12.11.5). Harvest exemptions are treated in §12.6.4.

### 12.11.1 Rest: the whole day, the forenoon, or the time of the sermon

**Not a commandment, but good order.** The first Saxon visitors already gave the principle. The ceremonies of the church, the holy days among them, are not commanded by God. They are kept "for the sake of good order and peace", as each parish has the custom. **Ernestine Saxony, *Unterricht der visitatoren an die pfarrherrn*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 164):

> Denn solche stücke sind mehr von nöten, denn am freitag fleisch essen und der gleichen, wiewohl dasselb für gott und im gewissen recht ist. Doch sollen die leute dennoch unterrichtet werden, bescheidenlich von solchen kirchenordnung zu reden, denn etliche kirchenordnung sind gemacht umb guter ordnung und fridens willen, wie S. Paulus spricht in der 1. zun Corinthern am 14.: Es sol alles ordentlich in der kirchen geschehen. Darumb sollen die feiertag, als sontag und etliche mehr, wie jeder pfarr gewonheit ist, gehalten werden.

For such things are more needful than to eat flesh on Friday and the like, although that is right before God and in the conscience. Yet the people shall nevertheless be taught to speak modestly of such church orders; for some church orders are made for the sake of good order and peace, as St Paul saith in the first to the Corinthians, the fourteenth: Let all things be done in order in the church. Therefore the holy days, as Sunday and some more, shall be kept, as is the custom of each parish.

**Degrees of rest.** In practice the orders set three degrees:

- **Sunday and the high feasts**: no work all day;
- **the half holy days**: no work until noon, or until the sermon was over (§12.6.1);
- **the other holy days**: no work during the service only.

A visitation recess for an Oldenburg parish states the difference between Sunday and the other holy days in one sentence. It lists the work forbidden: carting turf, hay and sheaves, ploughing, harrowing, mowing and digging. The penalty is that the offender's horses are unharnessed until he pays. **Oldenburg, *Visitationsabschied für Bardenfleth*, 1609** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1201):

> damit auf Sontagen gänzlich, die andern feiertage uber aber unter der predigt, mit torf-, heuw-, garbenfuhren, pflugen, eggen, meyen schwelen, graben und in andere wege mit der handarbeit eingehalten, auch bey wehrendem gottesdienst niemand bier oder wein gezapfet, und die muetwilligen verbrecher der gebuer mit auspannung der pferde biß zum abtrag gestraffet […] werden

that on Sundays wholly, but on the other holy days during the sermon, there be refraining from carting turf, hay [and] sheaves, from ploughing, harrowing, mowing, [and] digging, and in other ways from handiwork; also that during divine service no one tap beer or wine; and that the wilful transgressors be punished as is due by unharnessing of the horses until [the fine be] paid […]

**Work allowed after the sermon.** Pfalz-Zweibrücken allowed field work on all holy days except Sunday and the three high feasts, "especially in harvest and autumn", on condition that the people had first heard the sermon. The reason given was that "some holy days hinder working people in their living", while giving the idle occasion "to feast, carouse and drink wine". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Generalartikel*, 1560** (Sehling 18, p. 293):

> Und nachdem die underthonen uff dem Land hiebei auch clagsweiß furbracht, das ettlich feuertag arbeitsame leuth an irer Narung hindern, den andern aber, so one das ursach zum Mussiggang suchen, zu fressen, sauffen und weindrincken glegenheit geben, so mögen wir leiden, daß ausserhalb der dreyer hoher fest und dem heyligen Sontag die ubrigen Feiertag, sonderlich inn Erntt- und herbstzeith, unsere underthanen ire nottwendige Veldt- und andere arbeith besuchen mögen, Doch daß sie zuvor denselbigenn Dag gottes wortt und die Predig besucht haben.

And whereas the subjects in the country have also brought forward complaint hereupon, that some holy days hinder working folk in their living, but give to others, who without that seek occasion for idleness, opportunity to gorge, carouse and drink wine, we are content that, apart from the three high feasts and the holy Sunday, on the other holy days, especially in harvest and autumn time, our subjects may attend to their necessary field and other work; yet so that on that same day they have first attended God's word and the sermon.

**"Loose holy days".** Where the lesser feasts had been kept by halves, the people treated them as working days altogether. A Henneberg pastor complained that on the days "which the common man is wont to call loose holy days" the villagers did their road-mending and timber-carting, and went hunting after the early sermon. **Wasungen, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 2, pp. 356–357):

> dann dieweil man an andern orten dise feirtag zum theil abgeschaffet und das geschrei gangen, sie sollen bald gar fallen, hat man auf solche feirtag, die der gemein man lose feirtag pflegt zu nennen, allerlei gemeine und eigene arbeit fürgenomen, als gemeine weg machen, in die landwer geen, bauholzfüren und dergleichen mer […]. Zu frue thut man eine predigt. Darnach jage man oder erbeit jederman was er will.

for because in other places these holy days have been in part abolished, and the cry hath gone forth that they shall soon fall altogether, men have undertaken on such holy days, which the common man is wont to call loose holy days, all manner of common and private work, as making the common ways, going to the land-defences, carting building timber and more of the like […]. Early a sermon is done; thereafter one hunteth, or every man worketh what he will.

#### 12.11.2 Enforcement: gates, fines and taverns

**The town gates shut.** The Brandenburg visitors told town councils to shut the gates on holy-day mornings, so that no one could go out to work in the fields. **Cölln on the Spree, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 194):

> Es ist den visitatorn glaubwirdig vorkommen, das viele ungehorsamer leute sein, die den feiertag mit fahren und arbeiten, auch sonst verunheiligen, soll derwegen ein erbar rath die thore des heiligen tages vor mittage zuhalten, niemands daraus zur arheit gestadten

It hath come credibly before the visitors that there are many disobedient people who profane the holy day with carting and working, and otherwise also; therefore the honourable council shall keep the gates shut on the holy day before noon, [and] suffer no one [to go] out of them to work

The same order recurs in the visitation recesses for Salzwedel 1579 and Stendal 1578 (Sehling 3, pp. 285, 300, 331).

**Fines.** The town mandates fix the fine. Strasbourg (1534, Moderate Reformed) forbade every kind of handiwork on Sunday: stacking wood, unloading wood or sand, bucking and washing. The fine was thirty shillings. Milk and bread might be sold, and in Lent fish, until the last bell for the sermon. **Strasbourg, *Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung*, 1534** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 246):

> Erstlich, die weill der Sontag zu hörung Götlichs wortz verordnet, das niemantz in der stat Straßburgk oder deren burckban uf die Sontag on sonder dapfer, redlich ursach oder erheischende notturfft kheinerley handarbeit thun solle, es sey mit holtz legen, holtz oder sant uffschiessen, bauchen oder ußweschen oder andern arbeitten, wie die sind, bey peen dreissig schilling pfennig.

First, since Sunday is ordained for the hearing of God's word, that no one in the city of Strasbourg or its precincts shall on Sunday, without special weighty [and] honest cause or pressing need, do any handiwork whatsoever, be it with stacking wood, unloading wood or sand, bucking or washing, or other works, whatever they be, on pain of thirty shillings pfennig.

The discipline orders of the Wetterau counts set fines for each offence: for walking in the fields during the sermon, for trading, for sitting in the wine-house or working in the field (Hanau-Münzenberg, *Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim*, 1596, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 414; see Chapter 11 §11.12 for the fines for absence and for disturbing the sermon). Taverns were to stay shut during divine service on Sundays and holy days alike.

### 12.11.3 Weddings, guild feasts and markets

Wedding feasts, guild banquets and markets were moved away from the high feasts, so that they would not draw people from the sermon. The closed seasons for weddings in Advent and Lent are treated in §12.12.6.

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 240):

> Von den hochzeiten auf die heuptfeste. Weil es auf die heuptfest sehr unbequem ist, das in den selbigen wirtschaften gehalten werden, so sollen hinfurt dieselben auf solche feste genzlich ein gestellet sein, und auf weinachten acht tage zuvor, und für dem sontage nach trium regum, desgleichen in ostern, für dem sontage quasimodogeniti, auch in pfingsten, für dem sontage trinitatis keine hochzeit gestattet werden

Of weddings at the chief feasts. Forasmuch as it is very unmeet that wedding-feasts be held at the chief feasts, the same shall henceforth be wholly stayed at such feasts: and at Christmas, eight days before, and until the Sunday after the Three Kings; likewise at Easter until the Sunday Quasimodogeniti; and at Whitsuntide until the Sunday Trinity, no wedding shall be allowed

**Hadersleben, *Zuchtordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 23, p. 244):

> Es sollen auch die gilden auf den hohen festen und sonderlich dem Pfingstdage nicht mehr gehalten, besundern auf den andern tag verschoben werden.

The guild-feasts also shall no more be held on the high feasts, and especially on Whitsunday, but be put off to another day.

**Brandenburg, *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 129):

> Die obrigkeiten sollen auch verordnen, das die wochenmerkte, so an hohen festen gefallen, bis nach mittage oder auf den andern folgenden tag verschoben, auf das gottes wort dadurch nicht möge verhindert werden.

The magistrates also shall ordain that the weekly markets which fall on high feasts be put off until after noon, or to the next day following, that God's Word be not hindered thereby.

### 12.11.4 Fastnacht, Kirchweih, May Day and Midsummer

**"Heathen" festivals.** The folk festivals of the year were attacked as "heathen" in mandate after mandate:

- Shrovetide (*Fastnacht*) with its masks, dances and begging for eggs and meat;
- the church-dedication fair (*Kirchweih*, *Kirmes*);
- May Day and Walpurgis night, with the May-tree;
- Whitsun ales, the *Pfingstbier*;
- the Midsummer fires of St John's Eve;

- the *Hagelfeier*, a day of processions against hail.

The Hessian *Reformationsordnung* of 1572 (Philippist) forbids "Sunday dances, especially during the sermon and the catechism", and all such "frivolous wantonness". **Hesse, *Reformationsordnung*, 1572** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 401):

> Also auch sollen die sontagstänze, sonderlich under der predigte und kinderlehr, darzu auch alle andere leichtfertige üppigkeiten, so nach heidnischer weis zur fastnacht, Walpurgis, Pfingsten, Joannistag und andern zeiten mehr durchs jar vom gemeinen man geübt und vorgenommen werden, genzlichen verboten sein und die uberfahrer jedermals nach gestalt der geübten leichtfertigkeit durch unsere beampten ernstlichen gestraft und uns die straf einbracht werden. Wann aber hochzeiten seind, mag man zimlich tanzen

So also shall the Sunday dances, especially during the sermon and the catechism, and also all other frivolous wantonness which is practised and undertaken by the common man after heathen manner at Shrovetide, Walpurgis, Whitsuntide, St John's day and at other times more through the year, be wholly forbidden; and the transgressors shall each time be earnestly punished by our officers according to the form of the wantonness practised, and the fine brought in to us. But when there are weddings, one may dance modestly

The same list recurs in Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (with the "*Hagel* holy days" and the Walpurgis and St John's fires, Sehling 10, p. 310), Solms 1603 (Sehling 9, p. 351) and Ysenburg (Sehling 10, p. 707). Separate *Fastnacht* mandates were issued in Waldeck (1547, 1563, 1589/90), Ysenburg (1590, 1612, Reformed) and Baden (1610) (Sehling 9, pp. 222, 297, 301; 10, pp. 593, 693; 16, p. 572). Kurpfalz banned church-dedication fairs, Shrovetide and mummery outright in its police legislation (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 14, p. 66), and Waldeck abolished the *Kirchweih* in 1583 (Sehling 9, p. 299). The Franconian order of Thüngen named Corpus Christi and the *Hagelfeier* together as feasts "whereby God is blasphemed" (Sehling 11, p. 737).

#### 12.11.5 Shrove Sunday turned into a feast of baptism

**A new feast in place of an old one.** Bugenhagen's Hamburg order turned the Sunday before Lent, the beginning of Shrovetide, into a day for preaching on baptism. The Gospel was the baptism of Christ (Matthew 3). He remarks that there had never been a feast of Christ's baptism, though there had been "so many useless feasts". **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 507):

> Darumme is vor gudt angeseen, den vastelavendes sundach besundergen to bruken to predike van der dope. Des morgens schallme in allen karspelkarcken prediken dat evangelion Matth. 3, wo Christus gedopet in der Jordane von sunte Johannes. Dat is eine trostlike und gnadentrike historie van dem heren Christo, de jo nicht vorschwegen schall werden. Idt is wunder, dat me nicht hefft gehat ein fest van der dope Christi, dewile me doch so vele unnutte feste hefft gehadt tho vorderve lives und der selen.

Therefore it is thought good to use the Shrove Sunday especially for preaching of baptism. In the morning there shall be preached in all the parish churches the Gospel of Matthew 3, how Christ was baptized in the Jordan by St John. That is a comfortable and gracious history of the Lord Christ, which surely shall not be kept silent. It is a wonder that there hath not been a feast of the baptism of Christ, whereas there have been so many unprofitable feasts, to the ruin of body and soul.

The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 has the same rule (Sehling 23, p. 94). The Pomeranian *Agenda* of 1569 explains its purpose: the people are to be reminded of their baptism, "that by God's Spirit they may be the more led away from the heathenish, unchristian Shrovetide doings" (Sehling 4, p. 473).

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## 12.12 The seasons of the year

The evangelical orders kept the shape of the church year: Advent, Christmas, Lent, Holy Week, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun and the Trinity season. What they changed was what each season meant in practice. Lent lost its fast (§12.13) but kept its preaching. The seasons with the most extra services were Lent and Holy Week. Their additions were sermons and catechism, not Masses. This section covers Luther's starting point (§12.12.1), Advent (§12.12.2), Lent (§12.12.3), Holy Week (§12.12.4), Rogation week and the catechism seasons (§12.12.5), the closed seasons for weddings (§12.12.6) and the Ember days (§12.12.7).

#### 12.12.1 Luther: no special show for Lent

**The *Formula missae*.** Luther would not mark Lent, Holy Week or Good Friday with rites that set them apart from the rest of the year. To do so, with the half-Mass of the Presanctified and the denial of the cup, would be "to mock and laugh at Christ". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Porro gradualia quadragesimalia et similia, quae duos versus excedunt, cantet quisquis velit in domo sua. In ecclesia nolumus tedio extingui spiritum fidelium. Sed nec ipsam quadragesimam sive maiorem hebdomadam aut sextam feriam penosam aliis ritibus ostentare decet, quam alias quascunque, ne semimissa et altera sacramenti parte Christum amplius ludere et ridere velle videamur. Alleluia enim vox perpetua est ecclesiae, sicut perpetua est memoria passionis et victoriae eius.

Further, the Lenten graduals and the like, which exceed two verses, let whosoever will sing at home. In the church we will not have the spirit of the faithful quenched with tedium. Neither is it meet to display Lent itself, or the Greater Week, or the Friday of the Passion, with other rites than any other [days], lest we seem to wish to mock and laugh at Christ any longer with a half-Mass and with one part of the sacrament. For the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, even as the memory of his passion and victory is perpetual.

In 1526 he said the same of Holy Week, which "shall be even as other weeks", with the Passion preached an hour a day (*Deutsche Messe*, Sehling 1, p. 16; see Chapter 11 §11.4.4). The later orders did not all follow him in the chant. Some left the *Gloria* out in Lent and used the plain Kyrie (§12.10.11).

### 12.12.2 Advent

**The coming of Christ.** Advent is kept as a season of preaching on the prophecies of Christ's coming and on the Last Day. The Pomeranian *Agenda* gives weekday sermons for it. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 463):

> Wo men överst im advente up de werkeldage schal predigen, de prophecien van der tokümpst Christi, unde des herren Christi predigen vam jüngsten dage, dat volget herna.

But how one shall preach in Advent on the working days, the prophecies of the coming of Christ and the Lord Christ's sermons of the Last Day, that followeth hereafter.

Advent was also a season for the catechism. At Allstedt (1533) the pastor was to examine the children "three times in the year, in Advent, in Lent and after the harvest" (Sehling 1, p. 511). The Niederwildungen catechism order of 1533 (Waldeck) held the catechism three days a week in Advent (Sehling 9, p. 191).

### 12.12.3 Lent: repentance, the Passion and the catechism

**Preaching.** Lent kept its old name, *die Fasten* or *Quadragesima*, but its content became preaching. The Württemberg order sets the themes: repentance through Lent; on Palm Sunday the whole Passion read to the young people in three parts; on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday the Passion expounded. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 267):

> In der Fasten, Quadragesima genannt, soll von der rechten Christlichen buß gepredigt werden. Auf den Palmtag ist es nutzlich, neben der historien des Palmtages dem jungen volck die historien des gantzen Passions zu dreien malen, Nämlich morgens, nach mittag und zur Vesper zeit außgetheilt, fürzulesen, Und hernach dieselb historien auff den grünen Donnerstag unnd Charfreitag der gmeinen kirchen außzulegen und iren nutz und gebrauch mit sonderlichem ernst und fleiß zuerklären.

In Lent, called *Quadragesima*, there shall be preaching of right Christian repentance. On Palm Sunday it is profitable, beside the history of Palm Sunday, to read to the young people the history of the whole Passion, divided into three times, namely morning, afternoon and at Vesper time; and thereafter to expound the same history to the common church on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday, and to explain its profit and use with special earnestness and diligence.

The same text stands in Pfalz-Neuburg 1554, Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557, Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 and Kurpfalz 1556 (Sehling 18, pp. 207, 520; 14, p. 163). The division of the Passion into a series of Lenten sermons is described in Chapter 11 §11.4.4.

**More weekday sermons.** In Lent the weekday sermons were increased. In the Corvey village of Bruchhausen there was a sermon one day a week through Lent and two in the week before Easter. **Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603** (Sehling 21, p. 243):

> Uber diese itzt ermehlte Feyer- und Bettage soll auch in der Fasten Wochentlich einen tag in der Wochen, aber für Ostern zwey tage, des Donnerstages und Freytages, predige gehalten und dem Volck die Historia von dem Leiden Christi fürgehalten werden.

Over and above these holy days and prayer days now named, there shall also in Lent be preaching weekly one day in the week, but before Easter two days, the Thursday and Friday, and the history of the Passion of Christ be set before the people.

**Daily catechism instead of the *Salve Regina*.** The commonest daily service of Lent was the catechism, held at the hour when the *Salve Regina* had once been sung. **Gotha, *Artikel durch die hern visitatores einem erbarn rathe zu Gotha zugestellet*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 569):

> Alle tage in der fasten, als bald den ersten sontag anzufahen, da man im bapstumb das abgottische salve regina gesungen, wird der catechismus alle tage bis auf den sontag palmarum, mit den kindern gehalten, wird ein psalm als der 8. 16. 22. 69. 110. etc., die der passion Christi gedenken, neben dem stuck des catechismi, das da sol gehandelt werden, gesungen, darnach wird ein lection, ausm siracide, proverbiis Salomonis oder was sonst von pfarhern fur eine lection angeordnet, gelesen

Every day in Lent, beginning straightway on the first Sunday, [at the hour] when in the papacy the idolatrous *Salve Regina* was sung, the catechism is held with the children every day until Palm Sunday. A psalm is sung, as the 8th, 16th, 22nd, 69th, 110th etc., which remember the Passion of Christ, beside the part of the catechism which is to be handled; thereafter a lesson is read out of Sirach, the Proverbs of Solomon, or whatever other lesson is appointed by the pastor

Calenberg 1542 gives the same rule (Sehling 6/2, p. 804). The Upper Lusatian orders of Zittau and Herwigsdorf had the catechism preached every weekday in Lent "at Salve time" (Sehling 3, p. 379).

**The Easter communion and the examination.** Lent ended in the Easter communion, which drew the young people "in great number" (Regensburg 1572, Sehling 13, p. 509). The catechism was therefore examined on the Sundays of Lent. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 424):

> Zum andern sol der pfarrer auf den sontag Esto mihi etc. der gemein verkündigen, das hinfüro auf die sontage in der fasten nach der mittags predigt das examen mit den kindern und hausgesind gehalten werde, derhalben die eltern ihre kinder und gesinde darzu schicken und anhalten wollen, darmit sie aus ihrem catechismo rechenschaft ihres glaubens geben können.

Secondly, the pastor shall proclaim to the congregation on the Sunday *Esto mihi*, etc., that henceforth on the Sundays in Lent, after the midday sermon, the examination shall be held with the children and household servants; wherefore the parents shall send and hold their children and servants thereto, that they may give account of their faith out of their catechism.

There was no daily Lenten Mass. The orders hold the Supper when there are communicants (§12.10.9). In Lent the extra services are sermons, catechism and examination.

The Lenten catechism course is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.1, and the catechism service in Chapter 10, §10.10.

### 12.12.4 Holy Week

**Maundy Thursday and Good Friday.** The two days kept their themes: the institution of the Supper and the Passion. In Hamburg the morning service on Maundy Thursday was held "as on a Sunday, with the ceremonies", with a sermon on the sacrament. On Good Friday the Passion was preached. **Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 5, p. 544):

> In der vasten up den guden donnersdach schall ein itlick pastor to achte schlägen predigen vam sacramente des lives und blodes des heren Christi, wente vormiddage schall idt in der karcken alse sunsten up einen sondag mit den ceremonien geholden werden, alse wente nu her geschehen iss. Am guden freidage schall ein idtlicker pastor de passion des heren predigen to achte schlägen, doch schal idt einem iedern pastoren freiestahn, desülvige in der vasten antoheven, wenehr eme dat belevet, lank oder kort to tracterende.

In Lent, on Maundy Thursday, every pastor shall preach at eight o'clock of the sacrament of the body and blood of the Lord Christ; for in the forenoon it shall be held in the church as otherwise on a Sunday, with the ceremonies, as hath been done until

now. On Good Friday every pastor shall preach the Passion of the Lord at eight o'clock; yet it shall be free to every pastor to begin the same in Lent, when he pleaseth, to treat it long or short.

Most orders keep Maundy Thursday and Good Friday as holy days, at least in the forenoon (§12.6.2). The old Holy Week ceremonies (palms, the ass, the grave, the Easter fire) were abolished (§12.10.10). Weddings were not held in Holy Week (§12.12.6).

### 12.12.5 Rogation week and the catechism seasons

**Processions abolished.** The Rogation processions through the fields (*Kreuzgänge*, *Bittgänge*) went with the other processions (§12.10.10), and the *Hagelfeier* against hail was condemned (§12.11.4).

**The week kept for the catechism.** Bugenhagen kept Rogation week (*Krützeweke*) as one of four seasons for preaching the catechism through in eight sermons, by the superintendent and his adjutor. During these weeks the other preachers rested from their weekday sermons. **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 378):

> In der Advente twe wekene des Mandages, Dynxtedages, Donredages unde Frydages. In den ersten vullen twen weken in der vastene ock so. In der krützeweke mit der navolgenden weke ock so, ane des Heren hemmelvartdach. Twe wekene na der ernte, ehr me den hoppen afnympt, ock so. Darumme moten de beyden predicanten den catechismum kort unde vorstendich vaten vor de simpelen, dat me den kan uthpredigen in den achte prediken.

In Advent two weeks, on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Friday. In the first two full weeks of Lent likewise. In Rogation week with the week following likewise, except the Lord's Ascension Day. Two weeks after the harvest, before the hops are taken down, likewise. Therefore the two preachers must frame the catechism briefly and understandably for the simple, that it can be preached through in the eight sermons.

Hamburg 1529 and Lübeck 1531 repeat the plan (Sehling 5, pp. 505, 352). The four catechism seasons stand where the Ember weeks had stood (§12.12.7).

### 12.12.6 Closed seasons: no weddings in Advent and Lent

**The old rule kept.** Most orders kept the medieval closed seasons for weddings: Advent, Lent (often from mid-Lent) and the high feasts. They gave a new reason: the wedding feast would draw people from the sermon. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

> Es sollen die Hochzeiten nit auff die hohe Fest, als auff Weyhenachten, Ostern, Pfingsten etc., Auch nit im Advent und in der Fasten, sonderlich nach Mitfasten, gelegt und gehalten werden, damit die Leuth dardurch von der Predigt deß Göttlichen Worts und dem H. Gottesdienst nit abgeführet

Weddings shall not be laid and held on the high feasts, as on Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide, etc., nor yet in Advent and in Lent, especially after mid-Lent, that the people be not thereby led away from the preaching of God's word and the holy service

Strasbourg states the closed seasons exactly and adds that "we do not distinguish the times after the popish, superstitious manner". **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 636):

> Wiewol wir aber die Zeit nit auff Bäpstische Abergläubische weise unterscheiden, Jedoch, weil alles ding seine Zeit hat und durch etlicher weniger Freude und Kurtzweil des grössern hauffen Andacht nit solle verhindert werden, So ist bei uns gebräuchlich, Das von dem dritten Sontag des Advents biß auff den ersten Sontag nach dem Newen Jahrs tag keine Hochzeiten außzuruffen oder einzusegnen angenommen werden, Deßgleichen auch nit von Laetare oder Mitfasten biß auff Ostern.

Although we do not distinguish the times after the popish, superstitious manner, yet, because everything hath its time, and the devotion of the greater number shall not be hindered by the joy and pastime of a few, it is the custom with us that from the third Sunday of Advent until the first Sunday after New Year's day no weddings are accepted to be proclaimed or blessed; likewise also not from *Laetare* or mid-Lent until Easter.

The same ban, with dispensations "for great causes", is in Saxony 1580, the Upper Palatinate 1579, Grubenhagen 1581, Lüneburg 1575, Stendal 1551, Marienhafe (East Frisia) 1593 and Oldenburg (Sehling 1, p. 436; 13, p. 316; 6/2, p. 1065; 6/1, p.

672; 3, p. 316; 7/1, p. 718; 7/2.1, p. 1180). Mansfeld extended it to the octaves of the high feasts (§12.11.3). Hoya forbade weddings and other feasting through Lent and Holy Week, "that every one may prepare himself by a sober, moderate life" for the memory of Christ's passion (Sehling 6/2, p. 1200).

#### 12.12.7 The Ember days: from fast days to quarter days

**The fast gone, the date kept.** The Ember days (*Quatember*, *Fronfasten*, Low German *quatertemper*) were the Wednesday, Friday and Saturday after Invocavit, Whitsunday, Holy Cross (14 September) and St Lucy (13 December). The orders do not keep them as fasts (§12.13). They keep them as the four quarter days of the church year. Their uses in the orders:

- **Payments.** The communicants' offering penny was paid "every Ember time", as were schoolmasters' fees, salaries and poor-relief accounts. This is the commonest use by far.
- **Catechism sermons.** The catechism was preached through in each Ember season. **Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 676):

> Der katecismus soll vier mal des jars gepredigt werden, nemlich in den vier quatember. Ein itzliche quatember zwu oder drei wochen dazu zu nemen und dieweil der catecismus weret, die andern predigten ruhen lassen.

The catechism shall be preached four times a year, namely in the four Ember seasons. Each Ember season two or three weeks shall be taken for it, and while the catechism lasteth the other sermons shall rest.

- **The Litany.** Albertine Saxony had the Litany sung "on the four Ember seasons for a week" (Sehling 1, p. 272), and Mansfeld "especially on the four Ember days, when the people are together" (Sehling 2, p. 239).
- **Ordinations.** In Pomerania candidates were examined and ordained "at the time of the Ember days, especially in Lent and at Michaelmas, when the catechism is repeated", so that the ordinands might hear how the catechism was preached. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 395):

> Dat examen in der lere schal gescheen ut dem examine ordinandorum, locis communibus, ut dem catechismo unde im texte der hiligen schrift, unde sölckes up de tidt der quatertemper, sunderlick in der vasten unde up Michaelis, wenn de catechismus repeteret wert, dat de ordinanden vort hören de form, den catechismum to predigen.

The examination in doctrine shall be done out of the *Examen ordinandorum*, the *loci communes*, the catechism and the text of holy Scripture, and that at the time of the Ember days, especially in Lent and at Michaelmas, when the catechism is repeated, that the ordinands may straightway hear the form of preaching the catechism.

- **Ordinances read from the pulpit.** The forbidden degrees of marriage and the list of offences to be reported were read from the pulpit at every Ember season in Nassau (Sehling 10, pp. 95, 115). The Pfalz-Neuburg edicts were to be read "four times a year at the Ember times" (Sehling 13, p. 115).
- **Marriage sermons.** Henneberg 1582 held a half-hour sermon on marriage on the Sunday after each Ember season (Sehling 2, p. 314).

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## 12.13 Fasting

The medieval Church kept about 160 fast and abstinence days a year (Sehling's note, Sehling 11, p. 92):

- the forty days of Lent, on the weekdays from Ash Wednesday to Holy Saturday;
- the Friday abstinence, and in many places the Saturday;
- the Ember days;
- the vigils of the great feasts.

On these days meat, and in Lent also eggs and dairy, were forbidden on pain of mortal sin. The evangelical orders removed the obligation, kept the praise of fasting, and replaced the fixed fasts with occasional days of fasting and prayer. This section covers the principle (§12.13.1), the call to voluntary fasting (§12.13.2), the orders that kept the old fasts (§12.13.3), fasts kept for civil reasons (§12.13.4), the days of fasting and prayer (§12.13.5) and fasting before communion (§12.13.6).

#### 12.13.1 Not a law, and not a merit

**Fasting set among human ordinances.** The visitors of 1528 list "appointed fasts, eating no flesh on Friday" among the ordinances made "to earn grace for sins", which may therefore "be let fall" (see Chapter 10 §10.3.4 for the passage). Eating meat on Friday is "right before God and in the conscience", and less needful to preach than the commandments (§12.11.1).

**Fasting good in itself.** The Lüneburg articles of 1527 put the evangelical teaching in one sentence. Fasting is "useful and good, to tame the body". But it is not to be kept so that anything is earned "by difference of food on appointed days". No pastor is to compel anyone "to a difference of times or of food"; the people are to be led to "a willing fasting and a moderate life". **Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527** (Sehling 6/1, p. 500):

> De achte artikel. Wo me syck ym vastende schal h o 1 d e n. Nademe ock vastent nütte unde gudt ys, den lycham tho temmen, jodoch nicht also to holdende, dat dorch underschedt der spyse an uthgetekeden dagen sunderlykes wes vordenet edder unhulde Goddes, so men ydt nicht helde, vorwerket wörde, sunder dewyle ydt Christus unde syne apostele, ock eine lange tydt darna de gemene christlicke kercke fryg gelaten, dat ein ytlick kerckhere nemande dwynge tho underschede der tydt edder spyse, sunder mer den wyllen Goddes se underrichte, dat ene solckes fryg gelaten tho etende ym namen des Heren, wat ene Got vorlenet, jodoch mit stedtlikem anholdende gödtlyckes wordes dem unvorstande unde frevel begegene, dat se nicht yn averfloth varen, sunder mer ein wyllich fastent unde metich levent annemen.

The eighth article. How one shall conduct himself in fasting. Forasmuch as fasting is useful and good to tame the body, yet not to be so kept that by difference of food on appointed days anything special be merited, or God's displeasure incurred if one kept it not; but since Christ and his apostles, and also for a long time thereafter the common Christian church, left it free, [it is ordered] that every pastor compel no one to a difference of times or of food, but rather instruct them in the will of God, that it is left free to them to eat in the name of the Lord what God granteth them; yet, with constant urging of God's word, he shall meet ignorance and wantonness, that they fall not into excess, but rather take up a willing fasting and a moderate life.

**"Who ever taught that Christians should not fast?"** The Calenberg order of 1542 answers the charge that the evangelicals "teach nothing but to gorge on flesh". The answer has four points. Fasting is to last the whole of life, not to be bound to fixed times. It is not to be drawn into justification. It is not to be commanded on pain of mortal sin. And the difference of foods is not to be suffered, "because Christ hath freed us from such ordinances". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 772):

> denn wer hat jemals geleret odder geschrieben, das die Christen nicht fasten sollen? Man leret, was recht fasten sey, item, das nach der lehre Pauli solch fasten an keine bestimpte zeit gebunden sein, sonder die zeit unsers lebens weren solle, item, das solch werk in die justification nicht müsse gezogen oder bey einer todsunde, die gewissen damit zu bestricken, geboten werden, item, das man auch den unterscheid der speise hie nicht leiden könne, weil uns von Sollen satzungen Christus gefreiet habe

for who hath ever taught or written that Christians should not fast? We teach what right fasting is; item, that according to the doctrine of Paul such fasting is not bound to any fixed time, but shall last the time of our life; item, that such a work must not be drawn into justification, nor be commanded on pain of a mortal sin, to ensnare the consciences therewith; item, that the difference of food cannot be suffered here, because Christ hath freed us from such ordinances

The Mecklenburg *Klosterordnung* of 1572 and the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel *Klosterordnung* of 1569 explain the old fish days as a piece of the monastic "house order", which had wrongly been turned into "a special service of God" (Sehling 5, p. 252; 6/1, p. 307).

### 12.13.2 Fasting exhorted, but free

**The transitional orders.** The earliest orders of the 1520s and 1530s keep the old fast days as a recommended custom. They tell the preachers to exhort the people to keep them, and to live moderately every day, but they forbid any command under the ban or mortal sin. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526** (Sehling 11, pp. 92–93):

> Von fasten und fleischessen. Sollen die pfarherrn und prediger das volk vermanen, das sie nit allein in der virzigteglichen fasten, den quottembern und andern bisher gehaten fastagen, sunder teglich in meßigkeit und abbruch oder on uberfluß essens und trinkens leben, damit sie ire fleischliche leib zemen und geschickt machen, Gottes willen und werk zu volbringen und zu üben [...]. Und dieweil man sich nach ordnung etlicher heiligen veter und concilien ein lange zeit an den bestimpten fasttegen fleisch, eir und anders zu essen Got zu lob und ere enthalten hat, wiewol on zweifel

> derselbigen heiligen veter und concilien meinung nit gewesen ist, jemand dardurch in geferlichkeit seiner seelen oder leibs zu setzen oder einen strick der sünden zu legen oder ein neue todsünd zu machen, sunder mer damit den menschen zu christlicher casteiung seins leibs zu furdern

Of fasting and eating flesh. The pastors and preachers shall exhort the people that they live not only in the forty days' fast, the Ember days and the other fast days kept hitherto, but daily in moderation and abstinence, or without excess of eating and drinking, that they may tame their fleshly bodies and make them fit to fulfil and practise God's will and work [...]. And whereas, by the ordinance of certain holy fathers and councils, men have for a long time abstained on the appointed fast days from flesh, eggs and other things, to the praise and honour of God, although without doubt it was not the meaning of the same holy fathers and councils thereby to put any one in danger of his soul or body, or to lay a snare of sin, or to make a new mortal sin, but rather therewith to further men to Christian chastening of their body

Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 and Jülich-Kleve 1525 (Roman Catholic humanist) have the same text (Sehling 10, p. 77; 21, p. 71).

**Before the Supper.** Oldenburg 1573, following Urbanus Rhegius, asks why Christians will not fast "once or twice in the year" before coming to the Lord's table, when "the first godly Christendom a thousand years ago kept the forty fast days, each according to his occasion". **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1081):

> Auch wenn er etwas ernstlichs von Gott bitten wil oder sich zu einer ernstlichen danksagung ins Herrn nachtmal schicken wil, so wird er auch zuvor durch anregung des Geistes Christi fasten oder messiglich und nüchtern leben. Wo ers nicht tut, so ist er noch gar fleischlich und ein titelchrist. Die erste frome christenheit vor tausent jaren hielte die vierzig fasttage, ein jeder nach seiner gelegenheit. Was sind wir für Christen, das wir im jar nicht ein- oder zweymal wollen fasten, wenn wir zu Gottes tisch gehen sollen?

Also, when he will ask anything earnest of God, or will prepare himself for an earnest thanksgiving in the Lord's Supper, he will beforehand, by the moving of the Spirit of Christ, fast, or live moderately and soberly. If he do it not, he is yet wholly carnal and a Christian in name. The first godly Christendom a thousand years ago kept the forty fast days, each one according to his occasion. What manner of Christians are we, that we will not fast once or twice in the year, when we are to go to God's table?

#### 12.13.3 Orders that kept the old fasts

**Waldeck 1528 and Baden.** A few orders kept the fasts as before. The articles for the Waldeck synod at Mengeringhausen in 1528 say "all fast days shall be kept as hitherto", with abstinence from meat "at the forbidden times". **Waldeck, *Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen*, 1528** (Sehling 9, p. 185):

> Alle fasttage sollen gehalten werden wye bißher. Fleysch zu essen sol man sich enthalten uff verpotten zeyten. Sontag, apostelntag, unser frawentag etc. soll man feyren umb des worts willen, aber doch in der zeytt der ernd etc. nymandt gewissen zu machen.

All fast days shall be kept as hitherto. One shall abstain from eating flesh at the forbidden times. Sunday, the apostles' days, Our Lady's days, etc., shall be kept holy for the Word's sake, but yet in the time of harvest, etc., no one's conscience shall be burdened.

The Margrave Philipp of Baden, in his mandate of 1531, still required "the forty days and other fast days brought down in the common Christian church, together with the Fridays and Saturdays", with abstinence from meat except in need or bodily weakness (Sehling 16, p. 507). The Colmar council, still Catholic (the city's Reformation came in 1575), complained in 1560 that the Lenten fast and "other fast days through the year" were kept with little discretion "among young and old, sick and healthy" (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 20/2, p. 481).

#### 12.13.4 Fasting by police order

**Meat days for the price of meat.** Where a magistrate ordered abstinence, the reason given was economic, and the order says so. The Nordhausen police order of 1549 forbids meat on Fridays, Saturdays and in Lent because the price of meat was rising. The old, the sick, hard labourers, young children and women in childbed are exempt. It declares that no one is to think it a sin. **Nordhausen, *Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen*, 1549** (Sehling 2, p. 396):

> Von fleisch essen und der fasten. Und deweil wir befinden, das der fleischkauf je lenger je mehr in grosse theurungen erwechst, so wollen wir, dass sich ein ider die wochen zwene tage, freitages und sonnenabends, auch die fasten des fleischessen enthalte, ausgeschlossen alte kranke leute, hartarbeiter, junge kinder, kindbetterin, oder den es auf befel der erzte erlaubt, doch das hierinne kein frevel oder missbrauch gesucht. Doch sol dieser artikel von niemand vorstanden werden, als ob es sünde und von gott vorboten were, die abgemelten zeit kein fleisch essen, welches auch von uns gar nicht gemeint, sondern wir wollen alles das, so gott der herr frei und ohne sünde zu gebrauchen gelassen hat, frei und ohne sünde bleiben lassen, und hierinne nicht anderst denn gehorsam und gut ordnunge, policei und messigkeit gesucht und gemeinet haben.

Of eating flesh and of Lent. And whereas we find that the buying of flesh groweth ever more into great dearness, we will that every one abstain from eating flesh two days in the week, Fridays and Saturdays, and also in Lent; excepted old [and] sick people, hard labourers, young children, women in childbed, or those to whom it is allowed at the bidding of the physicians; yet so that no wantonness or abuse be sought herein. Yet shall this article be understood by no one as though it were sin and forbidden by God not to eat flesh at the aforesaid time, which is in no wise meant by us; but we will let all that the Lord God hath left free and without sin to be used remain free and without sin, and herein have sought and meant nothing else than obedience and good order, police and moderation.

**The fish market.** Strasbourg's Sunday mandate (1534, Moderate Reformed) lets milk and bread be sold before the sermon, "and in Lent the fish" (Sehling 20/1, p. 246; §12.11.2). Lent still governed the market.

### 12.13.5 Days of fasting and prayer

**The new fast day.** In place of the fixed fasts, the orders appoint days of fasting and prayer (*Buß-*, *Bett-* and *Fasttage*) in times of war, plague, dearth and threat to the church. Some were monthly, some extraordinary. On them feasting and weddings were stopped, and the people were called to fasting as well as prayer. The Palatine mandate of 1610 (Reformed), issued as the Catholic League formed, tells the preachers to teach that "at dangerous, sorrowful times even permitted joys are to be laid aside". It also tells them to correct the false idea that "with the popish superstitious fasting the rightful Christian fasting also was done away". **Kurpfalz, *Mandat zu den Bußtagen*, 1610** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 971):

> 1. Wie daß zu gefehrlichen, trübseligen zeitten auch die erlaubte freuden einzustellenn. 2. Von dem gebrauch der kirche Gottes, sich durch fasten undt casteien des leibs zu einem eiferigen gebett vorzuberaitenn, da ihnen die falsche wahn zu benemmen, alß wann mit dem bäpstischen aberglaubigen fastenn auch das rechtmeßige christliche fasten were aufgehabenn.

1. How that at dangerous, sorrowful times even the permitted joys are to be laid aside. 2. Of the custom of the church of God, to prepare itself by fasting and chastening of the body for earnest prayer; wherein the false conceit is to be taken from them, as though with the popish superstitious fasting the rightful Christian fasting were also done away.

A Nassau-Weilburg text printed with the order of 1576 makes the monthly prayer days fast days, on which betrothal feasts, guild banquets and all weddings in the week were stopped (Sehling 10, p. 239). Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and Schleswig-Holstein ordered prayer days with fasting in the 1550s and 1560s (Sehling 8, p. 263; 23, p. 270). Kurland mentions extraordinary "fast days" set by edict in time of war (Sehling 5, p. 92).

**Fasting at the choice of ministers.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders follow Acts 13 and 14: the church is to prepare "with fasting and prayer" for the election of a superintendent or minister. **Micron, *Christliche Ordinancien* (1554; German edition 1565)** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 588):

> Wenn die gemeine eines dieners oder mehr dürftig ist, so wird alsdenn nach der ordnung Gottes ein gemeiner gewisser fasttag durch die eltisten angestellet, welcher tag darnach von der kanzel der ganzen gemeine verkündiget wird

When the congregation is in need of one minister or more, then, according to the ordinance of God, a common, certain fast day is appointed by the elders, which day is thereafter proclaimed from the pulpit to the whole congregation

The Hessian rule (Moderate Reformed) is at Sehling 8, p. 203, and the same provision is in Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 (Sehling 18, p. 560).

The prayer-day sermons are treated in Chapter 11, §11.4.5, and the Litany days in Chapter 13, §13.22.4.

#### 12.13.6 Fasting before communion

**Sober for the sacrament.** The one fast the orders still expected regularly was the communicant's. The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) defends receiving the sacrament fasting with Augustine: "it hath pleased the Holy Ghost that, in honour of this most worthy sacrament, the body of the Lord should enter the Christian's mouth before other food" (Sehling 8, p. 309). The Saxon order of 1580 forbids banquets on the eves of Sundays and feasts, so that the household might come to the sacrament sober. **Albertine Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 430):

> Sollen derwegen auf die sonn und hoher fest abend nicht allein alle gastungen abschaffen, sondern auch ein jeder hausvater sein ganzes hausgesinde zu einem nüchtern leben, vornemlich aber wenn sie zum hochwirdigen sacrament gehen, anhalten, auf das sie nüchtern, mit lust und andacht an folgendem sonn oder festtage gottes wort hören, die communion wirdiglich gebrauchen

They shall therefore not only do away with all banquets on the eves of Sundays and high feasts, but also every householder shall hold his whole household to a sober life, chiefly when they go to the most worthy sacrament, that they may hear God's word soberly, with delight and devotion, on the following Sunday or feast day, [and] use the communion worthily

**Who fasted, and how.** The orders give no general fasting rules for clergy or laity. What they show:

- **Communicants.** Communicants were expected to come fasting and to keep the eve soberly (§12.13.6 above).
- **Everyone on prayer days.** The whole congregation was called to fast on the appointed days of fasting and prayer, and to give up feasts and weddings (§12.13.5).
- **Under police orders.** Where the magistrate ordered abstinence for economic reasons, the old, the sick, labourers, children and women in childbed were exempt (§12.13.4).
- **No separate clergy fast.** No order lays a separate fast on the clergy. The monastic fasts went with the monastic rules: Württemberg's convent order of 1535 counts the bonds of human ordinances "in fasting, silence, confessing, wearing cowls and tonsures" among what is cast off (Sehling 16, p. 79).

Confession and communion as a duty of the laity are treated in Chapter 15, §15.8.3.

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### 12.14 Occurrence and transfer

The medieval rubrics had detailed tables of "occurrence" (two feasts on the same day) and "concurrence" (the vespers of one feast meeting the first vespers of the next). A feast of higher grade displaced one of lower grade, which was commemorated or transferred. The Lutheran orders keep the principle, but apply it to three practical cases:

- a feast that falls on a Sunday;
- the Annunciation in Holy Week;
- a lesser feast that falls on a Saturday, or in the same week as another.

Their rules show how the ranks of §12.5 were understood: Sunday against feast, feast of Christ against Passiontide, apostle against working week.

#### 12.14.1 A feast on a Sunday

The general rule is that a feast of Christ displaces the Sunday Gospel, while an apostles' day yields to it.

**Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 288):

> So aber grosse feste auf den sonntag fallen, als weinachten, S. Stephani, S. Joannis evangelistae, den neuen jars, der heiligen könige, purificationis M., annunciationis M., Joannis Baptista, visitationis M. und Michaelis, sol man die evangelia von den festen behalten. […] 7. Wen aber uff den sontage der apostel fest fallen, sol man die sontags evangelia behalten und die evangelia so uff die apostel fest fallen, auf den nachmittage predigen.

But if great feasts fall on the Sunday, as Christmas, St Stephen, St John the Evangelist, New Year's, the Three Kings, the Purification of Mary, the Annunciation of Mary, John the Baptist, the Visitation of Mary and Michaelmas, one shall keep the

Gospels of the feasts. […] 7. But when the apostles' feasts fall on the Sunday, one shall keep the Sunday Gospels, and preach the Gospels that fall on the apostles' feasts in the afternoon.

**Note.** St Stephen and St John count here as "great feasts", as days of Christmas, while the apostles do not.

Mansfeld sets out the apostles' days by the day of the week on which they fall. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 240):

> Felt ein apostel tag auf einen sontag, so mag er gehalten werden wie er gefellet, doch das man in den stedten in den kirchen, da man des sontags zwei oder drei mal predigt, auf derselbigen predigt eine, das sontags evangelium auch auslege. Felt ein apostel tag auf einen montag, dienstag, mitwoch, donnerstag, oder freitag, kan man in auf den tag, darauf er gefellet in den stedten, wie es gebreuchlich ist, halten, da es aber breuchlich ist, denselben auf den nechstfolgenden tag, darinne man sonst wochen predigten helt, zuverlegen, da mag es bei solcher gewonheit bleiben. Felt aber ein aposteltag auf einen sonnabend, sol er auf den nechstfolgenden sontag verleget und gehalten werden.

If an apostle's day fall on a Sunday, it may be kept as it falleth; yet so that in the towns, in the churches where there is preaching two or three times on Sunday, the Sunday Gospel also be expounded in one of the same sermons. If an apostle's day fall on a Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday or Friday, it may be kept in the towns on the day whereon it falleth, as is customary; but where it is customary to remove it to the next following day whereon the week-day sermons are otherwise held, it may abide by that custom. But if an apostle's day fall on a Saturday, it shall be removed to the next following Sunday, and kept thereon.

**Note.**

- **Wintzingerode.** The order (Sehling 2, p. 256) has the same rules. There the apostle's Gospel goes to the Sunday afternoon.
- **Thorn 1575.** Small feasts falling near a Sunday go to its vespers (§12.5.6).
- **Danzig 1612.** A small feast falling on a Sunday is rung like a great one (§12.5.6).
- **Nördlingen 1579.** A local thanksgiving day falling on a Sunday is to be kept "solenniter wie andere hohe festa" (Sehling 12, p. 388).

### 12.14.2 The Annunciation in Holy Week

The Annunciation (25 March) often falls between Palm Sunday and Low Sunday. The orders count it as a feast of Christ. It cannot simply be dropped, and it may not displace the Passion and Easter. The orders give at least six solutions:

| Solution | Orders |
|---|---|
| The Saturday before Palm Sunday (*Palmabend*) | Hadersleben 1528; Schleswig-Holstein 1542; Merseburg 1544; Anhalt 1568; Pomerania 1569; Sayn 1582 |
| Palm Sunday itself, in the forenoon | Aschersleben 1575; Schwarzburg 1587; Wintzingerode (only if it falls Wednesday to Saturday, "per anticipationem") |
| A weekday of the week before Palm Sunday | Waldeck 1556 (Wednesday after Judica); Hoya 1571 and Harlingerland 1573/74 (Thursday after Judica) |
| The Sunday after Easter ("nach alter gewonheit") | Prussia 1526, 1544 and 1568 |
| Maundy Thursday | Burzenland chapter, 1573 (a proposal of the dean for that year) |
| Omitted that year | Ysenburg 1582 |
| A convenient day agreed with the neighbouring churches | Thorn 1575 |

**Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528** (Sehling 23, p. 64):

> Wnser frowen vorkundinge dach (unnd wen de up den Gronen Donnersdach valt effte darnha, ßo sal me ohn eintrechticklich up den Sonnavent vor Palmarum holden, sunst sal me ohn nicht transfereren)

Our Lady's Annunciation day (and when it falleth on Maundy Thursday or thereafter, it shall be kept with one accord on the Saturday before Palm Sunday; otherwise it shall not be transferred)

**Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 20):

> Mit verlegung aber der fest, das annunciationis Marie, do dis in die marterwoche gefiele, auf den palmabent gelegt wurde. Der andern feste verlegunge solle durch das consistorium bestimbt und idem superattendenten den pfarhern in synodis angezeiget werden.

But as touching the removing of the feasts: that the Annunciation of Mary, if it should fall in the week of the Passion, be laid on the eve of Palm Sunday. The removing of the other feasts shall be determined by the consistory, and shown to the parsons in the synods by the superintendent.

**Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 469):

> Wenn de dach der vorkündiginge Marie velt in de stilleweke, idt si weckeren dach idt si, schal men dat fest vorlegen up palmavend unde sölckes am sondage Iudica to vörne affkündigen.

When the day of the Annunciation of Mary falleth in the still week, be it what day it be, one shall lay the feast on the eve of Palm Sunday, and bid the same beforehand on the Sunday Judica.

**Wintzingerode (Gericht Bodenstein), *Kirchen-Ordnung*** (Sehling 2, p. 256):

> So das fest annunciationis Mariae in der marterwochen auf einen montag oder dienstag einfellet, so soll es auf dieselbigen gehalten werden. Fellet es aber auf den mittwochen, grünen donnerstag, charfreitag oder oster abent, soll mans (wie es die alten nennen) per anticipationem zurück auf den palm-sontag feiern.

If the feast of the Annunciation of Mary fall in the week of the Passion on a Monday or Tuesday, it shall be kept on the same. But if it fall on the Wednesday, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday or Easter Eve, one shall keep it holy (as the ancients call it) *per anticipationem*, back upon Palm Sunday.

**Note.** *Per anticipationem* is the old term for moving a feast back, before its date. "As the ancients call it" shows that the orders knew they were using the medieval rules of transfer.

**Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587** (Sehling 2, p. 137):

> Wenn aber das fest Adnunciationis, wie bisweil geschicht, in die marter wochen gefiel, soll er auf den sontag palmarum gelegt und vormittag solenniter gehalten, das evangelium aber desselben sontags nachmittag geprediget werden

But if the feast of the Annunciation, as sometimes happeneth, fell in the week of the Passion, it shall be laid on Palm Sunday and kept solemnly in the forenoon, but the Gospel of the same Sunday be preached in the afternoon

**Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 272):

> Es soll aber diß fest (ergerliche ungleicheit zue verhuten) mittwochen nach Judica gehaltenn werden, wens auf den palmtag oder in palmwochen fellet, sonst sol es auff den tag, [auf den] es kompt, gehalttenn werdenn

But this feast shall be kept (to avoid offensive inequality) on the Wednesday after Judica, when it falleth on Palm Sunday or in Palm week; otherwise it shall be kept on the day whereon it cometh

**Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 87):

> Wann der tag Conceptionis Christi oder Annunciationis Mariae auf den palmtag oder in der woche vor ostern oder dieselbige folgende wochen in den ostertagen gefellt, soll er den nechsten sonntag nach ostern gehalten und lauts der vorigen kirchenordenung transferirt werden, damit dieselbige zeit vom einreiten des herrn Christi und sein heiliges leiden sammt der historien der auferstehung unverhindert nach nothdurft müge geprediget werden.

When the day of the Conception of Christ or the Annunciation of Mary falleth on Palm Sunday, or in the week before Easter, or in the same following week in the Easter days, it shall be kept on the next Sunday after Easter, and be transferred according to the former church order; that the same time may be preached, without hindrance and as need requireth, of the riding in of the Lord Christ and his holy Passion, together with the history of the resurrection.

**Note.** The rule goes back to the Prussian order of 1526 (Sehling 4, p. 38). That order keeps the day after Easter "nach alter gewonheit", after the old custom, which is the medieval practice of transferring the Annunciation to the week after Low Sunday.

In 1573 Easter fell on 22 March, so the Annunciation fell on the Wednesday after Easter. The dean of the Burzenland chapter writes. **Burzenland chapter (Transylvania), resolutions of 25 February 1573** (Sehling 24, p. 371):

> 6. In veteri ecclesiae computo festum Annuntiationis Mariae sive Conceptionis Christi assignatum est 25 Martii, qui cadit in diem Mercurii post resuscitatum Christum, ubi alia plura festa concur[...]runt. Si tunc celebraverimus illud, ingluviem et intemperantiam auxerimus in nostratibus. Calendariorum vulgarium huius anni authores retraxerunt in diem sabbathi ante Palmarum. Is dies profanis mercaturis plus quam celebrationi festorum dicatus est. Ego igitur festum illud celebrabo ad feriam 5 ante Pascha, quae dicitur dies Coena Domini.

6. In the old reckoning of the Church the feast of the Annunciation of Mary, or Conception of Christ, is assigned to the 25th of March, which falleth on the Wednesday after Christ's rising again, when several other feasts concur. If we celebrate it then, we shall increase gluttony and intemperance among our people. The makers of the common calendars of this year have drawn it back to the Saturday before Palm Sunday. That day is more given to profane marketing than to the celebration of feasts. I will therefore celebrate that feast on the fifth day before Easter, which is called the day of the Lord's Supper.

The Thorn order admits that practice varies. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, pp. 239–240):

> Weil es aber mit erwehlung eines bequemen tages nicht in allen orten gleichförmig gehalten wird, wie in denen alten und neuen kirchenordnungen zusehen, so ist es am sichersten, auch am bequemsten, dass man sich mit denen um und nahe gelegenen kirchen und städten vergleiche, das fest mii ihnen auf einen tag zuhalten, ob sie gleich nicht [...] alle in der religion mit uns zustimmen, damit nur der schwachen etlicher massen wahrgenommen werde.

But because in the choosing of a convenient day it is not held alike in all places, as is to be seen in the old and new church orders, it is surest and also most convenient that one agree with the churches and towns lying round about and near, to keep the feast with them on one day, though they do not [...] all agree with us in religion; only that the weak may in some measure be cared for.

#### 12.14.3 Saturdays, harvests and two feasts in one week

Henneberg gives a rule for the "common feasts" of the second rank. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 313):

> Wenn aber ein gemein fest auf einen sontag gefiele, sol desselbigen sontags verordnetes evangelium fort geprediget, das fest verkündiget, und, das auf nechstfolgenden mitwochen die historien oder fests evangelium zu predigen verlegt sei, dem volk angezeigt werden. So aber zwei oder mehr gemeine fest in eine wochen fielen, sol das erste auf den tag, darauf es gefellt, gehalten, des andern fests historia oder evangelium aber auf den folgenden mittwoch der andern wochen ordentlich gehandelt, und solches gleichwol allwege auf den sontag zuvor verkündiget werden.

But if a common feast should fall on a Sunday, the Gospel appointed for the same Sunday shall be preached as usual, the feast proclaimed, and it shall be shewn to the people that the history or Gospel of the feast is removed to be preached on the next following Wednesday. But if two or more common feasts fall in one week, the first shall be kept on the day whereon it falleth; but the history or Gospel of the other shall be orderly handled on the following Wednesday of the next week; and this nevertheless shall always be proclaimed on the Sunday before.

**Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575** (Sehling 2, p. 479):

> Wan aber das fest auf einen sonnabent felt, so wird es vorlegt bis auf den sontag nachmittage. Weil auch der tag Jacobi apostoli in der ernten kompt, pflegt man das fest, wan es auf einen freitag oder sonnabent gefelt, auf den nechsten sontag darnach nachmittage zuhandeln.

But when the feast falleth on a Saturday, it is removed until the Sunday afternoon. Also, because the day of James the apostle cometh in the harvest, it is the custom, when it falleth on a Friday or Saturday, to handle the feast on the next Sunday after, in the afternoon.

In Schwarzburg apostles' days are not moved, except from a Saturday. **Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587** (Sehling 2, p. 137):

> die festa der aposteln, sollen ohne unterlassung und ohne einige vorlegung auf den tag, do sie gefallen, feierlich gehalten werden, vormittag dan auch die orgeln, wo man sie hat, gebraucht werden sollen [...] doch wan ein solch apostel fest auf einen sonnabend gefellet, soll es den sonntag hernach zur vesper volgen und gehalten werden

the feasts of the apostles shall be kept solemnly, without omission and without any removing, on the day whereon they fall; in the forenoon also the organs, where there be any, shall be used [...] yet when such an apostle's feast falleth on a Saturday, it shall follow on the Sunday after, at vespers, and be kept then

#### 12.14.4 Moving not allowed

Against these rules for moving feasts, several orders forbid pastors to move feasts on their own authority, whether for markets or to save themselves work.

**Salzwedel (Altstadt), *Visitations-Abschied*, 1579** (Sehling 3, p. 275):

> darum verordenen die visitatores, das der pfarherr und caplene allhie die festage, an den tagen, daran sie gefallen, inhalts der kirchen und visitationordenunge christlich und solemniter halten und nicht nach ihren gefallen verschieben oder verlegen, noch einige fest auslassen sollen, ungeachtet, do die gleich auf die marktage gefielen

therefore the visitors ordain that the parson and chaplains here shall keep the feast days on the days whereon they fall, according to the church and visitation orders, in Christian manner and solemnly, and not put them off or remove them at their pleasure, nor leave out any feast, notwithstanding they should fall on the market days

**Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590** (Sehling 19/1, p. 389):

> Es soll auch kein Pfarrherr Macht haben, dieselbige Fest oder Feyertage zuverlegen auff andere Tag, sondern sich genügen lassen zu feyren auff die Tag, darauff sie fallen, damit kein Ungleichheit gehalten werde zum Ergerniß und Nachrede, etc.

Neither shall any parson have power to remove the same feasts or holy days to other days, but he shall content himself to keep them holy on the days whereon they fall, that no inequality be held, to offence and evil report, etc.

The Kosd and Schelken statutes continue after the sentence quoted in §12.3.7. **Kosd and Schelken chapters (Transylvania), statutes, 1577** (Sehling 24, p. 400):

> Si quis vero in gratiam suorum colonorum aliquem diem festum celebraverit, qui in cathalogo festorum non est, aut festum in alium diem celebrandum reiecerit, poena capituli punietur

But if any, to please his peasants, shall have celebrated any feast day which is not in the catalogue of feasts, or shall have put off a feast to be celebrated on another day, he shall be punished with the chapter's penalty

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### 12.15 The short calendars: Upper German towns and the Reformed

At the other end from the conservative lists of §12.5.7 stand the orders that kept only Sunday and a handful of high feasts. In these the question of rank hardly arises: there is Sunday, and there are the few feasts of Christ that remain. They are mostly Upper German cities under Zwinglian or Bucerian influence (Reformed or Moderate Reformed), and later Reformed territories. Their history shows how unstable the minimum was.

Mülhausen's first step (Reformed) keeps four "high-tides" with the Marian feasts and the apostles, and abolishes the local and lesser days. Among them is "der achtest Sannt Steffans", the octave of St Stephen, the only octave named in any list of abolished feasts. **Mülhausen (Alsace), council decree on processions and holy days, 1524** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 196):

> Das unnd anders angesehen, ist geordent, das man hinfur den heiligen Sonntag vorab unnd darzu die hohen fest: die vier hochzitt, Unnser lieben frawen unnd der appostel tag eeren unnd began sol, wie ge[…]wonheit ist. Aber dise nachbestimpten tag, mit namen: der Kindlin tag, der achtest Sannt Steffans, Marcus, die zwen heilig crutztag, keyser Heinrich […] Magdalena, Sant Steffan im Ougsten, Laurentius, kalte kilby, Gallus, Lucas, Katherina, Nicolaus, Ostermitwoch unnd Pfingstmitwoch, die alle sollen hinfur nit mer gebotten werden zu feyren noch fur feyrtag gehalten; aber nütdestminder sollen deren gedechtnuß uff yedes tag in der kilchen beganngen werden, vorab mit verkhundung des gotsworts unnd darnach mit den emptern der meß, wie gewonheit ist

This and other things considered, it is ordained that henceforth men shall honour and keep first the holy Sunday, and thereto the high feasts, the four high-tides, our dear Lady's days and the apostles' days, as the custom is. But these days hereafter appointed, by name: the Children's day, the eighth day of St Stephen, Mark, the two holy Cross days, the Emperor Henry […] Magdalene, St Stephen in August, Laurence, the cold church-hallowing, Gallus, Luke, Catherine, Nicholas, Easter Wednesday and Whitsun Wednesday: these shall all henceforth be no more commanded to be kept holy, nor held for holy days; but nevertheless their memory shall be kept on each day in the church, first with the proclaiming of God's Word and thereafter with the offices of the mass, as the custom is

**Note.** The "cold church-hallowing" (*kalte kilby*) is the dedication feast of Basel Minster, 11 October. The "four high-tides" at Mülhausen are Christmas, Easter, Ascension and Pentecost (see the next quotation).

Five years later Mülhausen adopted the Basel order (both Reformed). **Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel and Strasbourg orders, 1529** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, pp. 214–215):

> Item mit den feyertagen sols noch Baßler ordnung gehalten werden, die nit meer dann den Winachsdag, den Uffart-, den Ostertag und Pfingstag mit […] sampt den Sontagen zu fyren verordnet haben.

Item, with the holy days it shall be kept after the Basel order, which hath ordained to keep holy no more than Christmas day, Ascension day, Easter day and Whitsunday, together with the Sundays.

**Augsburg, *Feiertagsordnung* of the council, 22 July 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 84):

> so hat ein rat derhalben angesehen und erkennet, das furohin allein die sonntäg - und alle abent der sambstäg um drei ur nach mittem tag anzufahen desgleichen der Christag, Ostertag und Pfingstag (ußerhalb einiger nachfeir), […] dazu der Neujarstag, der tag der Auffart Christi und der tag der Verkundigung Mariä gefeiret werden, dardurch alle und jede andere feirtag alhie, keinen ausgenommen, hiemit aufgehebt sein sollen, also das meniglich an allen und jeden andern tagen außerhalb der obbemelten feirtäg wol arbeiten und in schwais des angesichts die narung suchen mag.

therefore the council hath considered and resolved that henceforth only the Sundays (and every Saturday evening, to begin at three of the clock after midday), likewise Christmas day, Easter day and Whitsunday (without any after-holiday), […] thereto New Year's day, the day of the Ascension of Christ and the day of the Annunciation of Mary, be kept holy; whereby all and every other holy day here, none excepted, shall hereby be taken away, so that every man may on all and every other day, beside the holy days aforesaid, well work and seek his living in the sweat of his face.

**Note.** "ußerhalb einiger nachfeir", "without any after-holiday", abolishes the second and third days of the great feasts. The Saturday evening, from three o'clock, is treated as part of the Sunday.

The Esslingen council (Moderate Reformed) first abolished everything but Sunday and Christmas (22a), then brought the apostles' days back (22b). **Esslingen, council decrees of 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, pp. 389–390):

> Dweil aber ein ersamer rath vermerckt, das an solichen feirtagen das gemein volck meher zu offen zechen unnd anderer leichtfertigung dann zuverkhindung des gotlichen worts geneigt, damit dann solich ubel, so uß dem miessiggang entsteen, abgestelt und ain jeder zu theglicher arbeit getzogen, hat ein ersamer rath alle feirtag ausserhalb das deß heiligen sontags unnd weihenacht tag gentzlich abgeschafft und will, das der selbigen khainer meher gefeirt, besonder ain jeder sich an solichen tagen zu seiner teglichen arbeit geschickt mache. […] und aber yetzo augenscheinlichen befunden, das, gleich so wol uff die gute montag allso hievor uff die feirtag geschehen, alle fillerei unnd unzucht, sonderlich bey dem jungen folck jern fürganng haben, aber allein dem hailsamen Gottes wort kein zeit noch weil gegebenn werden mag […] so thut ir ersam […] weißhait auß disen hievor erzellten unnd anndern mehr beweglichen

> ursachenn ordnen und will, das hinfiro nebenn denn gepannen sontägen der hailligen apostel tag widerumb gefeirt und an denselben das Gottes wort verkhint unnd gehört werde

But forasmuch as an honourable council perceiveth that on such holy days the common people are more given to open carousing and other lightness than to the preaching of the divine Word; that such evil, which ariseth out of idleness, may be put down, and every man drawn to his daily work, an honourable council hath wholly done away all holy days, beside the holy Sunday and Christmas day, and willeth that none of the same be kept holy any more, but that every man betake himself on such days to his daily work. […] and now it is found plainly that on the "good Mondays", even as heretofore on the holy days, all drunkenness and unchastity have their course, especially among the young folk, while no time nor leisure can be given to the wholesome Word of God alone […] therefore their honourable wisdom, for these causes aforesaid and more other weighty causes, ordaineth and willeth that henceforth, beside the commanded Sundays, the holy apostles' days be kept holy again, and God's Word be preached and heard thereon

**Note.** The "gute Montage" were the "blue Mondays" that craftsmen took off. The Esslingen council learned that abolishing holy days did not abolish holidays, and restored the apostles' days in order to have days for preaching.

At Strasbourg (1544, Moderate Reformed) only Sunday is a holy day in the city. The saints are remembered in the sermon, and the countryside may keep its half and whole days. **Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 342–343):

> Weil inn der stat allein der Sonnetag gefeiret würt, sollen die prediger das volck offt und mit allem ernst ver-[…]manen, das sie solche feyre dem Herren gentzlich heiligen. Sollen auch auff die selbigen, wann inn der wochen die tag fallen, auff […] welche man sunst der fürnemen werck Gottes, so er an seinem lieben son oder auch den apostolen und martyren gewürcket, gedechtnüssen und feire haltet, solcher gedechtnüssen, historien, wan man die inn der Schrifft oder sunst inn bewerten bücheren hat, dem volck fürtragen […] Wa aber auff dem land solche gedechtnüssen noch ire feire den gantzen oder halben tag haben, da solle man sie christlich behalten.

Because in the city only the Sunday is kept holy, the preachers shall oft and with all earnestness exhort the people that they hallow such rest wholly unto the Lord. They shall also on the same [Sundays], when the days fall in the week whereon otherwise memorials and holy days are kept of the chief works of God which he hath wrought in his dear Son, or also in the apostles and martyrs, set forth to the people the memorials and histories of the same, when they are had in the Scripture or else in approved books […] But where in the country such memorials still have their holy day, the whole or the half day, there they shall be kept in Christian wise.

The Nassau-Dillenburg order after the county turned Reformed. **Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 10, p. 163):

> 48. Omnia festa sanctorum et abusus feriarum abrogentur et soli Dominici dies atque festa Christi retineantur.

48. Let all feasts of the saints and the abuses of holy days be abrogated, and let the Lord's days only and the feasts of Christ be retained.

**Note.** The same county's Lutheran order of 1537 had kept Corpus Christi, the Assumption and the Nativity of Mary (§12.5.7, §12.8.9).

The Palatine order of 1556 had followed Württemberg (§12.5.3). Its Reformed successor keeps only the three great feasts, New Year and Ascension. **Kurpfalz (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 14, p. 397):

> Ordnung der feiertägen. An den feyertagen soll es gehalten werden wie am Sontag. Diese feyertag aber sollen gehalten werden: Alle Sontag. Der Christag sampt dem nechsten tag hernach. Der Jarßtag. Der Ostertag sampt dem nechsten tag hernach. Die Himelfahrt Christi. Der Pfingstag sampt volgendem Montag hernach.

Order of the holy days. On the holy days it shall be done as on Sunday. But these holy days shall be kept: all Sundays; Christmas day with the next day after; New Year's day; Easter day with the next day after; the Ascension of Christ; Whitsunday with the Monday following after.

**Note.** The editor notes that the 1556 order "hatte noch zusätzlich: Epiphanias, die Marien- und Aposteltage, Johannis Baptistae und Michaelis": it still had Epiphany, the Marian and apostles' days, John the Baptist and Michaelmas.

When Anhalt turned Reformed, the prince ordered a new agenda on the Palatine model. **Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg to the superintendent, 4 March 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 535):

> eine algemeine agenda dieses fursten thums kirchen, auf und nach der pfälzischen gerichtet und derselben gleichförmig, zuvorfassen, und dass in derselben der apostel und andere festa eingestellet, und in den dreien haubt festen mehr nicht dann zwene tage gefeiert, der dritte aber gar abgeschaffet

to draw up a general agenda for the churches of this principality, directed upon and after the Palatine one and conformable to the same; and that therein the apostles' and other feasts be discontinued, and in the three chief feasts no more than two days be kept holy, but the third be wholly abolished

**Note.** With these reductions, the ranking of §12.5 falls back to the two ranks of Luther's *Formula missae*: Sunday and the feasts of the Lord.

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## 12.16 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. Note that a single database record may hold several orders.
- **Notes**: a short description of the order's system, or of what it contributes to the chapter.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

**Luther; Saxony and Thuringia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1, pp. 5, 9 | 2 | two ranks: Sundays and "feasts of the Lord"; saints' feasts abolished or folded into Sunday preaching; Purification and Annunciation counted as feasts of Christ; Holy Cross "anathema" | 12.3.1, 12.4.3, 12.12.1 |
| Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528 | 1, pp. 164–169 | 9 | feasts of Christ "in sonderheit"; Marian, John, Michael, apostles, Magdalene desirable where not fallen away; Latin on high feasts | 12.3.4, 12.5.2, 12.10.1, 12.11.1, 12.13.1 |
| Amt Grimma, *Generalia*, 1529 | 1, p. 576 | 90 | high feasts three days, with vestments | 12.7.1 |
| Amt Leisnig, *Verordnung*, 1529 | 1, p. 610 | 105 | three high feasts three days, *festive* | 12.4.5 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Gemeine Verordnung*, 1533 | 1, p. 192 | 14 | Latin Mass on high feasts in towns | 12.10.1 |
| Altenburg castle chapter, 1533 | 1, p. 516 | 56 | more bells on Sundays and feasts | 12.10.7 |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 | 1, p. 274 | 30 | high chief feasts of Christ (incl. Purification, Annunciation, Maundy Thursday, Good Friday); then John, Visitation, Michael; apostles forenoon or moved to Sunday | 12.3.7, 12.5.2 |
| Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544 | 2, p. 20 | 1211 | whole-day feasts; forenoon feasts "ahne gebotene feir" (Maundy Thursday, Good Friday, apostles); Annunciation to Palm eve | 12.5.2, 12.14.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Burg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542 | 2, p. 427 | 1257 | vespers and sermon *in vigiliis* of high feasts | 12.4.6 |
| Gera (Plauen extract), 1556 | 2, pp. 158–159 | 1234 | feasts of Christ and apostles with Gospel histories; Stephen and John as Christmas days | 12.3.7 |
| Penig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 1, p. 634 | 116 | high feasts: 3, 2, 1 sermons on successive days | 12.6.3 |
| Schwarzburg, *Ordnung der fest und feiertage*, 1587 | 2, p. 137 | 1230 | three chief feasts three days (third forenoon only); seven feasts whole day *solenniter*; apostles forenoon, not moved | 12.7.1, 12.14.2, 12.14.3 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 | 2, pp. 312–313, 314 | 1247 | four chief feasts incl. Ascension, two sermons; "common feasts" one sermon, no organ; rules for occurrence | 12.6.3, 12.12.7, 12.14.3 |
| Goldlauter (Henneberg), 1566 | 2, p. 333 | 1248 | Christmas three days, Easter and Whitsun two | 12.7.2 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526 | 1, p. 16 | 3 | Holy Week "as other weeks" | 12.12.1 |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnunge zum anfang*, 1539 | 1, p. 272 | 30 | Litany on the four Ember seasons | 12.12.7 |
| Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533 | 1, p. 511 | 53 | catechism examined in Advent, Lent and after harvest | 12.12.2 |
| Gotha, visitation articles, 1555 | 1, p. 569 | 88 | daily catechism in Lent in place of the *Salve Regina* | 12.12.3 |
| Torgau, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529 | 1, p. 676 | 139 | catechism in the four Ember seasons | 12.12.7 |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 424, 430, 436 | 44 | Lenten examinations; sober eves before communion; no weddings in Advent and Lent | 12.12.3, 12.12.6, 12.13.6 |

**Harz counties, Magdeburg and Halberstadt, Anhalt**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 | 2, pp. 239–240 | 1241 | whole days and half days listed; apostles by day of the week; harvest apostles moved; no weddings at chief feasts | 12.6.2, 12.6.4, 12.11.3, 12.12.7, 12.14.1 |
| Wintzingerode (after Hohnstein), undated | 2, p. 256 | 1243 | whole days two sermons, third day of chief feasts one; half days; Annunciation *per anticipationem* | 12.6.2, 12.14.2 |
| Aschersleben, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1575 | 2, pp. 479–480 | 1260 | three chief feasts; eight "middle" feasts as Sundays, figural; apostles forenoon, *Kyrie apostolicum* | 12.5.5, 12.10.2, 12.14.3 |
| Ermsleben, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1564 | 2, p. 486 | 1260 | high feasts whole day, two sermons; apostles forenoon | 12.6.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Anhalt, Nicolaus Hausmann's order, 1532 | 2, p. 542 | 1262 | one wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Conception, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; apostles forenoon; night vigil of Christmas and Easter wished for | 12.4.6, 12.5.7 |
| Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, 1551 | 2, pp. 554–555 | 1262 | high feasts / other Sundays and feasts / weekdays *ferialiter* (no *Gloria*) | 12.4.5 |
| Hatzkerode (Anhalt), 1534(?) | 2, p. 587 | 1263 | preface on great feasts, exhortation otherwise | 12.10.3 |
| Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung* of Prince Bernhard, 1568 | 2, pp. 569–570 | 1262 | apostles, John, Magdalene, Purification, Annunciation, Michael kept; Visitation and Nativity of Mary *ferialiter*; high feasts two days figural, third Latin chorale; elevation on high feasts | 12.4.5, 12.7.1, 12.10.6 |
| Anhalt, Prince Johann Georg, 1599 (Reformed) | 2, p. 535 | 1261 | Reformed: apostles' and other feasts discontinued; high feasts two days only | 12.15 |
| Wasungen (Henneberg), *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1566 | 2, pp. 356–357 | 1250 | "loose holy days" turned to work | 12.11.1 |
| Nordhausen, *Polizei-Ordnung der Stadt Nordhausen*, 1549 | 2, p. 396 | 1254 | meat days for the price of meat | 12.13.4 |

**Brandenburg, Prussia, Pomerania, the Baltic, Poland and Silesia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung*, 1540 | 3, p. 87 | 1746 | one long list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary, All Saints, Martin, Laurence, Catherine | 12.5.7 |
| Neumark, visitation instruction, 1540 | 3, p. 36 | 1745 | collection on high feasts "nicht allein die vier zeiten" | 12.9.3 |
| Crevese nunnery, recess, 1541 | 3, p. 203 | 1762 | Office *de tempore* and of high feasts; saints' days from the *commune sanctorum* | 12.4.4 |
| Brandenburg, *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573 | 3, p. 129 | 1748 | markets on high feasts moved | 12.11.3 |
| Salzwedel (Altstadt), visitation recess, 1579 | 3, pp. 275, 285 | 1779 | feasts not to be moved to Sundays or market days | 12.11.2, 12.14.4 |
| Tangermünde, *Ritus*, 1603 | 3, p. 338 | 1788 | *summae festivitates* | 12.4.2 |
| Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568 (after 1526, 1544) | 4, pp. 38, 87 | 1833 | apostles forenoon only; Annunciation in Holy Week to the Sunday after Easter; Magdalene's Gospel on Trinity 7 | 12.6.1, 12.8.8, 12.14.2 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1535 | 4, p. 343 | 1856 | three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, John, Visitation, Michael | 12.5.4 |
| Pomerania, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 4, p. 356 | 1859 | Kyrie grades: *summum* on the higher feasts | 12.4.2, 12.10.11 |
| Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569 | 4, pp. 466–469, 463, 473 | 1865 | three great feasts three days, wholly kept; other feasts; apostles forenoon, *festivaliter* | 12.10.2, 12.10.5, 12.11.5, 12.12.2, 12.14.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | bells, no communion; Annunciation to Palm eve | |
| Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569 | 4, pp. 414, 395 | 1862 | the four-times penny | 12.9.1, 12.12.7 |
| Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 | 5, pp. 15, 17 | 1897 | all feasts of Christ, and the Visitation; paschal Kyrie on high feasts | 12.3.7, 12.10.2 |
| Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, pp. 89, 92 | 1907 | proper German prefaces on high feasts | 12.10.3, 12.13.5 |
| Danzig, St Mary's, 1567, with draft *Feiertagsordnung* | 4, pp. 186–187 | 1844 | feasts with four sermons and vigils; apostles, angels, Visitation two early sermons; third day disputed | 12.7.1 |
| Danzig, St Mary's, *Kirchenordnung*, 1612 | 4, pp. 203–204 | 1844 | great feasts (three sermons) and small feasts (one sermon), marked by bells | 12.5.6, 12.10.7 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 4, pp. 237–240 | 1844 | feasts of Christ, great feasts three days; "small or half feasts" two sermons, German office; Annunciation moved by agreement | 12.5.6, 12.10.1, 12.10.3, 12.14.2 |
| Posen, Bohemian Brethren, 1576 (Bohemian Brethren) | 4, p. 285 | 1846 | Sunday first in dignity, as moral law | 12.3.8 |
| Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584 | 3, p. 461 | 1815 | one long list incl. Nativity of Mary, Martin, Catherine; any may be a half day | 12.5.7 |
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1592 | 3, p. 445 | 1809 | three Marian feasts, John, Michael whole day; apostles one early sermon | 12.6.2 |
| Cölln on the Spree, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1540 | 3, p. 194 | 1759 | town gates shut on holy-day mornings | 12.11.2 |
| Salzwedel (Neustadt), visitation recess, 1579; Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1578 | 3, pp. 300, 331 | 1780, 1787 | town gates shut on holy-day mornings | 12.11.2 |
| Stendal, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1551 | 3, p. 316 | 1786 | no weddings in Advent and Lent | 12.12.6 |
| Zittau 1564 and Herwigsdorf 1595, church orders | 3, p. 379 | 1798 | catechism daily in Lent "at Salve time" | 12.12.3 |
| Pomerania, *Karcken ordening* | 4, p. 354 | 1858 | Latin Litany when kept *dominicaliter*, in Advent and Lent | 12.10.11 |

**The Low German north**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1528 | 6/1, pp. 380, 397–398, 441, 378 | 1983 | three great feasts three days, four sermons a day; other Gospel feasts fully kept; Michaelmas a four-times feast; apostles moved to Sunday; proper prefaces; a new feast of Christ's baptism | 12.3.3, 12.5.4, 12.8.5, 12.8.9, 12.10.3, 12.12.5 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 513–514, 528 | 1960 | as Braunschweig | 12.3.3, 12.5.4 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 | 5, pp. 362, 352 | 1949 | the four times: Easter, Whitsun, Michaelmas, Christmas | 12.9.1, 12.12.5 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 551 | 1963 | figural music on the chiefest feasts | 12.10.5 |
| Ritzebüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 559 | 1963 | whole-day holy days; half days until noon | 12.6.2 |
| Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 | 5, p. 421 | 1953 | "hohe vierzeiten feste" | 12.9.3 |
| Mecklenburg, *Ordeninge der misse*, 1545 | 5, p. 151 | 1922 | German *Kyrie summum* | 12.4.2 |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, pp. 200–201 | 1922 | high chief feasts of Christ; "over these chiefest feasts" apostles, John, Visitation, Michael (forenoon); Michaelmas replaces Assumption as four-times feast | 12.5.2, 12.8.8 |
| Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 1557 | 5, p. 224 | 1925 | Assumption not to be kept; Michaelmas the four-times feast | 12.8.3 |
| Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, c. 1560 | 5, p. 288 | 1936 | great feasts on Sunday displace the Sunday Gospel; apostles do not | 12.14.1 |
| Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572 | 5, pp. 252, 258 | 1926 | fish days a monastic house-rule; Athanasian Creed on high feasts | 12.10.8, 12.13.1 |
| Hadersleben, *Artikel*, 1528 | 23, p. 64 | 1576 | Latin on "groten feste" (*summa festa*); holy days listed; apostles not kept; Annunciation to Palm eve | 12.4.2, 12.14.2 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 23, pp. 90–95 | 1576 | three great feasts three days; feasts of Christ, Assumption, Visitation, John, Michael, All Saints; apostles on Sunday; Latin and sequences on high feasts | 12.3.3, 12.5.4, 12.8.5, 12.10.1, 12.10.4, 12.11.5 |
| Hadersleben, *Zuchtordnung*, 1573 | 23, p. 244 | 1599 | no guild feasts on high feasts | 12.11.3 |
| Gottorf, visitation articles, 1587 | 23, p. 371 | 1621 | preface *in summis festis* | 12.4.2 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung* (Bugenhagen), 1529 | 5, pp. 505, 507 | 1958, 1959 | Shrove Sunday a feast of baptism; catechism seasons | 12.11.5, 12.12.5 |
| Hamburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 5, p. 544 | 1962 | Maundy Thursday sermon on the sacrament; Good Friday Passion | 12.12.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, prayer days with fasting, 1553 | 23, p. 270 | 1602 | prayer days and fasting | 12.13.5 |

**Lower Saxony, Westphalia and the Lower Rhine**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Northeim, *Kirchenordnung*, 1539 | 6/2, pp. 934–935 | 2047 | "furnemliche feste" for the weak's sake; Corpus Christi kept for civil reasons | 12.3.5, 12.8.9 |
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 6/1, pp. 62–63 | 1972 | four times with first-vespers sermon; Stephen, John, John Baptist themes | 12.7.3, 12.8.6, 12.9.3 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 6/2, pp. 1032–1033 | 2056 | four chief feasts (four-times penny); seven "herliche fest"; apostles forenoon | 12.5.5 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 6/2, pp. 1151, 1186, 1200 | 2065 | four high feasts (Michaelmas for Assumption); feasts wholly kept; apostles until the sermon ends; Latin Mass on four-times feasts | 12.5.5, 12.9.3, 12.12.6 |
| Harlingerland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573/74 | 7/1, pp. 735–736 | 2122 | as Hoya, in three *Sectiones* | 12.5.5, 12.9.2 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 1096–1097 | 2150 | Mecklenburg scheme; Michaelmas as four-times feast; Corpus Christi abolished | 12.8.9, 12.9.2 |
| Buxtehude, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 7/1, p. 74 | 2082 | *Gloria* in Latin on high feasts | 12.10.1 |
| Buxtehude, *Agende*, 1565 | 7/1, p. 123 | 2082 | Kyrie grades *in summis festivitatibus*, *minus summum* | 12.4.2 |
| Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 7/1, p. 259 | 2099 | no special holy days; apostles until noon | 12.6.1 |
| Osnabrück (city), *Kirchenordnung*, 1613 | 7/1, p. 267 | 2100 | whole days (two or three sermons); half days (one sermon) | 12.6.2 |
| Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 22, p. 245 | 1505 | Nürnberg list; Assumption kept as four-times feast "for the working folk"; small feasts: no work during the sermon | 12.6.2, 12.8.3 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, pp. 391–392 | 1462 | Mecklenburg scheme; proper prefaces only on the four-times feasts | 12.9.2 |
| Goslar, SS. Simon and Jude, Office, 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 264 | 2194 | ferial, dominical and festal Office | 12.4.4 |
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1561 | 7/2.2, p. 513 | 2221 | thirteen feasts with Latin first vespers | 12.4.6 |
| Jülich-Cleves-Berg, visitation instruction, 1559 (Roman Catholic humanist) | 21, p. 87 | 1425 | "vier hochzeitoffer" | 12.9.1 |
| Lüneburg, *Artikelbuch*, 1527 | 6/1, p. 500 | 1996 | fasting free, "to tame the body" | 12.13.1 |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, p. 307 | 1978 | fish days a monastic house-rule | 12.13.1 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575 | 6/1, p. 672 | 2017 | no weddings in Advent and Lent | 12.12.6 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542 | 6/2, pp. 772, 804 | 2033, 2036 | "who ever taught that Christians should not fast?"; Lenten catechism | 12.12.3, 12.13.1 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1065 | 2058 | no weddings in Advent, Lent and the high feasts | 12.12.6 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1081 | 2149 | fasting before the Supper "once or twice in the year" | 12.13.2 |
| Oldenburg, visitation articles (Advent and Lent weddings); *Visitationsabschied für Bardenfleth*, 1609 | 7/2.1, pp. 1180, 1201 | 2151 | Sunday wholly, holy days during the sermon | 12.11.1, 12.12.6 |
| Marienhafe (East Frisia), *Kirchenordnung*, 1593 | 7/1, p. 718 | 2122 | no weddings in Advent and before Easter | 12.12.6 |
| Micron, *Christliche Ordinancien* (1554), German edition 1565 (Reformed) | 7/1, p. 588 | 2116 | fast day before the election of ministers | 12.13.5 |
| Corvey, *Kirchenordnung für das Corveyer Stiftsdorf Bruchhausen*, 1603 | 21, p. 243 | 1455 | weekly Lenten sermon, two before Easter | 12.12.3 |
| Jülich-Kleve, *Kirchenordnung*, 1525 (Roman Catholic humanist) | 21, p. 71 | 1421 | fasting exhorted, not commanded | 12.13.2 |

**Hesse, the Rhine and the Main**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hessen, Homberg *Reformatio*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 49 | 2249 | only feasts of the mysteries of redemption, one day each, and the Visitation | 12.3.2 |
| Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 75 | 2252 | named saints' days forenoon only | 12.3.5 |
| Hessen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 257–258, 203, 263, 309 | 2257 | feasts of Christ; Christmas "das fest aller festen" | 12.3.6, 12.13.5, 12.13.6 |
| Waldeck, *Landordnung*, 1525 | 9, p. 179 | 2300 | four high-tide feasts, Marian and apostles' days | 12.9.1 |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9, pp. 272–276 | 2300 | Mecklenburg scheme; Good Friday half; three apostles forenoon; Michaelmas fourth chief feast; three-lesson matins on high feasts | 12.4.3, 12.6.1, 12.14.2 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 | 10, pp. 74, 77 | 169 | wide list incl. Corpus Christi, Assumption, Nativity of Mary; harvest feasts to Sunday | 12.5.7, 12.6.4, 12.8.9, 12.13.2 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 | 10, p. 163 | 184 | Sundays and feasts of Christ only | 12.15 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576, and *Agende*, 1618 | 10, pp. 228, 239, 310 | 198 | twelve feasts like Sundays; apostles one sermon; 1618: half and whole | 12.6.2, 12.11.4, 12.13.5 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, visitation recess, 1609 | 10, p. 352 | 199 | whole days two sermons; third day, John, Visitation, Michael, apostles half | 12.6.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Agende*, 1582 | 10, p. 583 | 218 | day by day: whole, half, forenoon; harvest and market | 12.6.2 |
| Solms-Laubach, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1603 | 9, p. 356 | 2311 | whole days; forenoon days; Beheading and Magdalene to weekday sermons | 12.6.2, 12.8.8 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1582 | 19/1, pp. 368, 372–373 | 1090 | four classes: chief, middle (half), transferable, abolished | 12.5.5 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1, p. 389 | 1090 | one list; harvest apostles forenoon; no transfers | 12.6.4, 12.14.4 |
| Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1564 (Reformed) | 19/1, p. 467 | 1094 | *ferialiter* (whole) and *tantum fiet concio* (sermon only); patronal feasts | 12.4.5 |
| Leiningen-Hardenburg (Dürkheim), 1584 | 19/1, pp. 277–278 | 1076 | high feasts whole day; apostles forenoon | 12.6.2 |
| Landau, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1562 | 19/1, p. 61 | 1044 | high feasts of Christ whole; all others until noon | 12.6.2 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1561 | 18, pp. 297–298 | 973 | eight high feasts whole; all others forenoon only | 12.6.2 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, pp. 518–519, 520, 560 | 1011 | whole and half days; half days as days of prayer | 12.6.2, 12.12.3, 12.13.5 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed), *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 | 14, p. 397 | 504 | Christmas, New Year, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun only | 12.15 |
| Hesse, *Reformationsordnung*, 1572 (Philippist) | 8, p. 401 | 2272 | "heathen" Shrovetide, Walpurgis, Whitsun and St John customs | 12.11.4 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, visitation recesses, 1552 and 1570 | 10, pp. 95, 115 | 172, 180 | ordinances read at every Ember season | 12.12.7 |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, *Reformationsmandat für das Amt Rodheim*, 1596 (Reformed) | 10, p. 414 | 206 | fines for Sunday trading and field work | 12.11.2 |
| Ysenburg, *Fastnachtsmandate*, 1590 and 1612 (Reformed); police order | 10, pp. 593, 693, 707 | 221, 236, 239 | Shrovetide and folk customs forbidden | 12.11.4 |
| Solms, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603 | 9, p. 351 | 2311 | "heathen" folk customs forbidden | 12.11.4 |
| Waldeck, *Beschlüsse für die Synode von Mengeringhausen*, 1528; *Niederwildunger Katechismusordnung*, 1533; Shrovetide and *Kirchweih* mandates, 1547–1590 | 9, pp. 185, 191, 222, 297, 299, 301 | 2300 | old fasts kept (1528); Advent catechism; Shrovetide and *Kirchweih* abolished | 12.11.4, 12.12.2, 12.13.3 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Generalartikel*, 1560 | 18, p. 293 | 971 | work allowed after the sermon on lesser holy days | 12.11.1 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 (with Pfalz-Neuburg 1554) | 18, p. 207 | 967 | repentance in Lent; the Passion in Holy Week | 12.12.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546 | 14, p. 93 | 471 | festal plays and processions abolished | 12.10.10 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 14, p. 163 | 480 | repentance in Lent | 12.12.3 |
| Kurpfalz, police legislation (Sehling's introduction) | 14, p. 66 | 468 | *Kirchweih*, Shrovetide and mummery banned | 12.11.4 |
| Kurpfalz, *Mandat zu den Bußtagen*, 1610 (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 971 | 1204 | "rightful Christian fasting" not abolished | 12.13.5 |
| Baden, mandate of Margrave Philipp, 1531 | 16, p. 507 | 702 | Lenten, Friday and Saturday abstinence kept | 12.13.3 |
| Baden, *Fastnachtsmandat*, 1610 | 16, p. 572 | 719 | Shrovetide customs forbidden | 12.11.4 |

**Upper Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16, pp. 105–106 | 651 | high feasts of Christ; other feasts forenoon only | 12.3.4, 12.5.3 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16, pp. 266, 267 | 671 | holy days proclaimed by the magistrate; one list (two days at the great feasts) | 12.3.5, 12.5.3, 12.12.3 |
| Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1603 | 16, p. 559 | 715 | feasts and apostles forenoon *simpliciter*, field-work after | 12.5.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527 | 17/1, p. 53 | 755 | no holy day commanded by God; a civil list; Stephen and John as one day (B) | 12.3.5, 12.7.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, Brenz, sermon, 1527 | 17/1, p. 78 | 756 | feasts a civil ordinance | 12.3.5 |
| Esslingen, council decrees, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2, pp. 389–390 | 883 | all but Sunday and Christmas abolished; apostles' days restored | 12.15 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, p. 204 | 270 | one list; Assumption kept for the peasants, preached as Visitation | 12.8.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, chapter order, 1533 | 11, p. 314 | 276 | no saints' octaves or suffrages | 12.4.4 |
| Nürnberg, Veit Dietrich, *Agendbüchlein*, 1545 | 11, p. 538 | 297 | Visitation moved to 15 August | 12.6.4 |
| Weißenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 11, p. 662 | 308 | wide list; Stephen and John one day | 12.5.7 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, pp. 411, 472, 477 | 294 | Kyrie and *Benedicamus* grades; vigils; figural music for the chief feasts | 12.4.2, 12.4.6, 12.10.5 |
| Lohr (Rieneck), *Vesperordnung*, 1588 | 11, p. 699 | 318 | Latin first vespers of high and other feasts | 12.4.6 |
| Nördlingen, *Ordnung der ceremonien*, 1544 | 12, pp. 321–322 | 373 | *Kyrie summum* at Pentecost and Trinity | 12.4.2 |
| Augsburg, *Feiertagsordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 84 | 339 | Sundays, Christmas, Easter, Whitsun, New Year, Ascension, Annunciation only | 12.15 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, pp. 71, 77–78, 94–95, 96 | 386 | wide list incl. Assumption; others "ungefeiret in gedechtnus"; Scripture-history feasts break the *lectio continua* | 12.3.7, 12.4.3, 12.5.7, 12.10.10 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, Ottheinrich's order, 1547 | 14, p. 109 | 473 | prefaces *solemnis* and *dominicalis* | 12.10.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567 | 13, pp. 474–475 | 450 | feasts of Christ; apostles; John and Michael; communion only on feasts of Christ | 12.3.7, 12.5.5, 12.7.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526 | 11, pp. 92–93 | 259 | fasting exhorted, not commanded | 12.13, 12.13.2 |
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 11, p. 646 | 304 | "Wir glauben" for "Nun bitten" in Advent | 12.10.11 |
| Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 11, p. 737 | 326 | Corpus Christi and the *Hagelfeier* condemned | 12.11.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, edict, 1555 | 13, p. 115 | 395 | edicts read at the Ember times | 12.12.7 |
| Kurpfalz (Upper Palatinate), *Visitationsordnung*, 1579 | 13, p. 316 | 416 | weddings suspended in Advent and Lent | 12.12.6 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572 | 13, p. 509 | 452 | Easter communion of the young | 12.12.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15, p. 77 | 539 | festal plays and processions abolished | 12.10.10 |
| Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535 | 16, p. 79 | 647 | monastic fasts among human ordinances | 12.13.6 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, p. 155 | 762 | no weddings at the high feasts, in Advent and Lent | 12.12.6 |

**Alsace**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mülhausen, council decree, 1524 (Reformed) | 20/2, p. 196 | 1377 | four high-tides, Marian and apostles' days; lesser days abolished | 12.15 |
| Mülhausen, opinion on the Basel order, 1529 (Reformed) | 20/2, pp. 214–215 | 1382 | Sundays, Christmas, Ascension, Easter, Whitsun only | 12.15 |
| Strasbourg, synodal decrees, 1544 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, pp. 342–343 | 1312 | only Sunday in the city; countryside half and whole days | 12.15 |
| Strasbourg, *Mandat zur Sonntagsheiligung*, 1534 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 246 | 1296 | Sunday work fined; fish sold in Lent | 12.11.2, 12.13.4 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, p. 636 | 1344 | closed seasons for weddings | 12.12.6 |
| Colmar (Sehling's introduction; before the city's Reformation of 1575) | 20/2, p. 481 | 1407 | complaint of lax Lenten fasting, 1560 | 12.13.3 |

**Transylvania**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Honterus, *Reformationsbüchlein*, 1543 | 24, p. 189 | 1666 | feasts kept for their Scripture histories | 12.3.7 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Notes | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung*, 1547 | 24, p. 222 | 1669 | fuller matins and Latin *Te Deum* on greater feasts | 12.4.3 |
| Burzenland chapter, 1573 | 24, p. 371 | 1694 | Annunciation moved to Maundy Thursday that year | 12.14.2 |
| Kosd and Schelken, statutes, 1577 | 24, p. 400 | 1704 | only feasts with Scripture history; no transfers | 12.3.7, 12.14.4 |
| Mediasch synod, 1578 | 24, pp. 427–428 | 1707 | apostles' days *intercise*; feasts of Christ *totaliter* | 12.6.4 |
| Burzenland, *Visitationsartikel*, 1578 | 24, p. 452 | 1710 | weekday feasts only until noon | 12.6.4 |

# Chapter 13. Extraordinary Rites

This chapter covers the occasional and extraordinary rites of the church in the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks, for each rite:

- **Was it kept, recast or abolished?** Which medieval sacraments, consecrations and blessings survived in an evangelical form, and on what grounds were the others given up?
- **What was the full liturgy?** Where an order prints a form, what is its order of service, and what are its formulas, vows and prayers?
- **How did the orders differ?** How do the Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed forms compare, and which orders copied which?
- **Who performed it, and where?** The pastor, the superintendent, the consistory, the elders or the congregation; in the church, at the font, at the altar, in the house or at the grave.

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §13.1 summarizes the findings, and §13.2 sets out the scope, sources and method.
- §§13.3–13.9 deal with the sacramental acts and the rites of life and death:
  - §13.3, baptism;
  - §13.4, exorcism;
  - §13.5, churching;
  - §13.6, confirmation;
  - §13.7, marriage, with betrothal, its dissolution, divorce and annulment;
  - §13.8, the sick (including extreme unction), the dying, the condemned and the possessed;
  - §13.9, funerals and burial.
- §§13.10–13.13 deal with offices:
  - §13.10, ordination;
  - §13.11, installation of pastors, superintendents, abbots and bishops;
  - §13.12, minor orders, lay offices, church workers, and the religious (sick-women, nuns, convent heads, monks and novices);
  - §13.13, magistrates and civil offices.
- §13.14 covers the dedication of churches and the *Kirchweih*, and §13.15 the blessings of objects and their abolition.
- §13.16 covers the ban, excommunication, public penance and the restoration of the penitent, and §13.17 private confession and absolution.
- §13.18 covers processions, and §13.19 the tonsure, the return of churches and vessels to common use, and the deposition of ministers.
- §13.20 covers other occasional rites, chiefly the parish visitation.
- §13.21 covers the rites of particular feasts and seasons: Christmas, Candlemas, Ash Wednesday, Palm Sunday, Holy Week, Easter, Ascension, Whitsun, Septuagesima and Trinity.
- §13.22 covers the Litany, the suffrages and the Good Friday solemn prayers at the Mass and in the services that stood in for it.
- §13.23 is a table by order, and §13.24 a concordance of every order quoted.

Each topic is supported by quotations in the original language (Early New High German, Low German or Latin), each followed by an English translation.

## 13.1 Summary of findings

### 13.1.1 The main findings

**1. The sacraments: one rite kept whole, the rest reduced to Word and prayer.** Baptism was the rite the orders printed most often and most fully (§13.3). Of the other medieval sacraments, none survived as a sacrament, but all left an evangelical rite in their place:

- **Confirmation** became a catechetical examination with prayer and, in many orders, the laying on of hands (§13.6).

- **Marriage** became a "worldly business" blessed by the church (§13.7).
- **Ordination** became a call, examination, prayer and the laying on of hands (§13.10).
- **Penance** became private confession and absolution, without enumeration of sins (§13.17), and, for open sinners, public penance and absolution (§13.16).
- **Extreme unction** was abolished as without command; the orders read James 5 as the elders' prayer and replaced the oil with the Word, absolution and communion of the sick (§13.8.1).

**2. Baptism fell into four families** (§13.3):

- the received rite in German (Luther 1523, Nuremberg and Strasbourg 1524 (Moderate Reformed), Ansbach 1526, Brandenburg 1540);
- Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526, the Lutheran standard;
- the Upper German rite of Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) and Württemberg (Lutheran), without exorcism or cross;
- the Reformed rite of the Palatinate and the stranger churches, which forbade emergency baptism by women.

Salt, spittle, oil, the candle and the font blessing went almost everywhere. The chrism was kept only in Electoral Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§§13.3.2, 13.15.4).

**3. Exorcism became the confessional marker** (§13.4). The Lutheran orders kept Luther's shortened exorcism, glossed as a prayer and confession of original sin. The Upper German orders never had it after the 1520s. From the 1560s the Philippist and Reformed territories abolished it by mandate, and some Lutheran ones tolerated or softened it.

**4. No chrismation, no consecrations, no blessings of things.** No order:

- anoints at confirmation (§13.6);
- consecrates a bishop with a separate rite (§13.11.4);
- consecrates a church, altar or churchyard (§13.14);
- blesses water, salt, candles, ashes, palms, fire, the font, *Fladen*, herbs, wine or bells (§13.15).

The abolition lists run in nearly the same words from 1524 to the 1590s. Their grounds are that creatures are sanctified by God's word and by thanksgiving, that no command or promise of God stands behind the blessing, and that the blessed objects had become means of superstition.

**5. Churching survived in some places as thanksgiving** (§13.5). Many orders abolished the "leading in" of the mother after childbirth. Others kept her first churchgoing as a thanksgiving with prayer, and a few printed a form.

**6. The rites of the sick replaced unction with Word and Sacrament** (§13.8). The reserved sacrament and its procession were abolished, and communion was given in the house. Only the Ansbach diet of 1526 still kept leftovers in the sacrament house; the later orders count the communicants and have the minister or communicants consume what remains (§§13.20.3, 13.20.5). No order keeps the Mass of the Presanctified: on Good Friday there was a full communion or none (§13.20.4). Forms were written for the dying, the plague-stricken and the condemned. Pomerania 1569 gave a rite of prayer over the possessed in place of exorcism.

**7. Funerals became a testimony of faith** (§13.9). Vigils, soul-Masses and the Masses of the seventh and thirtieth day were abolished. Burial with procession, hymns, bells and, later, a sermon was kept as the church's witness to the resurrection, and it could therefore be refused to the impenitent and the excommunicate.

**8. Ordination was kept, mostly on the Wittenberg pattern** (§13.10). The Wittenberg pattern was a public call, examination, prayer, laying on of hands by the ministers and a charge. In Saxony it was given centrally at Wittenberg or Leipzig; in Hesse, Lippe and many later orders it was given in the candidate's own parish, joined to his installation. The vesting, the anointing of the hands and the delivery of chalice and paten were dropped. Installation (*Investitur*) of a pastor in his parish was a separate rite, led by the superintendent (§13.11).

**9. Lay offices were filled by oath, pledge or election, not by rite** (§13.12). Laying on of hands for elders and deacons is found only in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London church and the Palatinate 1592 (both Reformed). Sextons, schoolmasters, churchwardens and midwives were bound by pledge or oath. The sexton was also the sacristan; no order has a separate sacristan or an altar guild. No order ordains or blesses a deaconess. Sick-women and beguines who nursed the sick were appointed by the council and examined or instructed by the pastor.

**10. Nuns were received with an evangelical rite; monks were not** (§§13.12.7–13.12.10). Keppel 1570 prints the one evangelical clothing of a nun. It consists of questions to parents, *domina* and candidate, an oath with the hand on the breast, a sermon, the clothing in the sacristy, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, an exhortation that the vows earn nothing and the convent is "no prison" but a school, and the *Te Deum*. Abbesses, prioresses and *dominae* were elected and swore oaths of office. No order admits a monk by profession: monasteries kept as schools received novices as scholars without vows. Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569 supplies the words with which a sister laid aside her cowl and crown, since baptism is the true clothing.

**11. Magistrates had no rite** (§13.13). The orders give the council-election sermon, the intercession for the magistrate and the clergy's place in the oath of homage, but no coronation or installation.

**12. The ban was rebuilt on Matthew 18** (§13.16). The lesser ban (exclusion from the Sacrament) was distinguished from the greater ban (public exclusion and "delivering to Satan"). The Lutheran territories gave the decision to the consistory. Wittenberg 1542, Mecklenburg 1570, Mansfeld 1580 and Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 print full forms of excommunication, public penance and absolution. The Reformed gave the decision to the congregation through its elders; Micron's London order prints a full liturgy of excision and readmission.

**13. Betrothal and divorce came under the church's eye** (§§13.7.8–13.7.10). Secret betrothals were made void; the pastor examined the betrothed before the banns (at Wertheim he presided at the betrothal itself); only the consistory could release a betrothed person or declare a spouse free after adultery or desertion; annulment was a declaration that no marriage had existed; and the innocent party's remarriage was quiet, without banns or pomp.

**14. The marks of the sacred state were dropped without rites of their own** (§§13.18–13.19). The processions with the sacrament, relics and holy water went, except in Electoral Brandenburg, which kept the Sunday, Palm Sunday and Rogation processions in a purified form. The processions that remained were led by a cross carried by a schoolboy or the sexton, then the singing schoolboys, then the clergy in surplices, then the people. No order puts a bishop, a deacon or any minor order in a procession, or has a thurible, torches, banner, canopy, crosier or Gospel book carried (§13.18.4). The tonsure was abolished and forbidden to the remaining old-believing clergy. Churches, altars and vessels were cleared out by authority and their goods turned to the common chest, without a rite of deconsecration. Unworthy ministers were deposed by a sentence read to the congregation, not degraded.

**15. The rites of the feasts were reduced to their history** (§13.21). No order keeps the *Exsultet*, the new fire, the paschal candle, the ashes or the Christmas Kalenda. Electoral Brandenburg 1540 alone kept the Palm Sunday procession, the Maundy Thursday foot-washing and the representations of Christ's burial and resurrection. Christmas and Easter Matins were moved from midnight to the morning, and the Good Friday solemn prayers survived at Mülhausen (Reformed) and Waldeck. No order buries the Alleluia at Septuagesima ("the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church", Luther), but several make the Athanasian Creed the text of Trinity Sunday.

**16. The Litany replaced the Mass without communicants, and the solemn prayers survived once** (§13.22). Luther's German and Latin Litanies, without the saints, were sung:

- in place of the Supper when no one communed (Mecklenburg 1552, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Grubenhagen 1544, which calls it the old "prayer-Mass");
- between epistle and gospel, during a long communion, or after the sermon, by boys kneeling before the altar or by the pastor from the pulpit;
- on Wednesdays and Fridays, in Rogation week and at the Ember seasons.

Zweibrücken (1533, 1574) tied it to the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks, and Schwäbisch Hall (1543) and Limpurg (1610) to Good Friday. Only Waldeck (1556) prints the Good Friday solemn prayers: eleven German biddings, each with a collect, without *Flectamus genua*, the pope or the pagans, and with new prayers for persecutors, false Christians and enemies. No order has a Litany at the Easter Vigil.

### 13.1.2 Where the full liturgies are

The forms printed in full or quoted at length in this chapter are:

| Rite | Principal full forms (§) |
|---|---|
| Baptism | Luther 1523 and 1526 (3.2–3.3); the anointings of Brandenburg 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (13.3.2); Saxony 1539 (13.3.4); Württemberg 1536/1553 and Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) (13.3.5); Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) (13.3.6) |
| Emergency baptism and its confirmation | Saxony 1539 (13.3.7) |
| Exorcism | Luther 1526 (13.3.3); its glosses and abolitions (13.4) |
| Churching | Mansfeld 1580 (13.5.2) |
| Confirmation | Ziegenhain 1539 (Moderate Reformed) (13.6.2); Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 (13.6.3); Brandenburg 1540 (13.6.4); Mansfeld 1580 (13.6.5) |
| Marriage | Luther 1529 (13.7.1); Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (13.7.2); Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) (13.7.3) |
| Sick and dying | Saxony 1539 (13.8.3); Dietrich 1545 (13.8.4, 13.8.6); Pomerania 1569 (13.8.7) |
| Burial | Saxony 1539/1540 (13.9.2); Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (13.9.3) |
| Ordination | Luther 1537–1539 (13.10.2); Merseburg 1545 (13.10.3); Regensburg 1553 (13.10.4); Hesse 1574 (Philippist) and the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.10.5) |
| Installation | Saxony 1580 and Wolfenbüttel 1569 (13.11.1); the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.11.2); Württemberg prelates (13.11.3) |
| Elders and deacons | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Micron 1554 and the Palatinate 1592 (Reformed) (13.12.1) |
| Deaconesses and sick-women | Nördlingen 1544, Heilbronn 1531 (13.12.6) |
| Clothing of a nun | Keppel 1570 (13.12.7) |
| Convent heads | Keppel 1570, Schleswig-Holstein after 1610 (13.12.8) |
| Novices and monks | Ravengiersburg 1560 (13.12.9); Württemberg prelates (13.11.3) |
| Laying aside the habit | Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569 (13.12.10) |
| Sextons, schoolmasters, organists, churchwardens, stewards | oaths and pledges: Lippe 1571, Heidelberg 1572 (Reformed), Anhalt 1594 (Philippist) (13.12.2); Mulhouse 1551 (Reformed), the Palatinate 1580, Gengenbach 1536 (Moderate Reformed), Hildesheim 1581 (13.12.3); Leisnig 1529, Saxe-Lauenburg 1585, the Palatinate 1577 (Reformed), Strasbourg 1523 (Moderate Reformed) (13.12.4) |
| Church dedication | Hof: the dedication of 1572, its yearly festival, and the school dedication of 1546 (13.14.3) |
| Betrothal, divorce, remarriage | Wertheim 1530 (13.7.8); Prussia 1575 (13.7.9); Saxony 1556, the Palatinate 1563 (Reformed), Brandenburg 1573 (13.7.10) |
| Excommunication, public penance, absolution | Wittenberg 1542 (13.16.2); Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 (13.16.3); Mecklenburg 1570 (13.16.4); Mansfeld 1580 (13.16.5); Grubenhagen 1581 (13.16.6); Micron 1554 (13.16.7) |
| Private confession and absolution | the catechism form, Palatinate 1556; Brandenburg 1540 (17.2–17.3) |
| Processions | Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2); order of march and objects carried: Stendal 1541, Brandenburg 1540, Waldeck 1556, Havelberg 1558, Hof 1592, Strasbourg 1598 (13.18.4) |
| Deposition of a minister | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) (13.19.3) |
| Visitation | Pfalz-Neuburg 1560 (13.20.1) |

| Rite | Principal full forms (§) |
|---|---|
| Litany in place of the Mass; Good Friday solemn prayers | Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Mecklenburg 1552, Grubenhagen 1544, Hof 1592 (13.22.1); Waldeck 1556 (13.22.2, 13.22.6); Pomerania 1569 (13.22.4) |

## 13.2 Scope, sources and method

### 13.2.1 The corpus and the rites covered

**The corpus.** The corpus is Sehling's edition, volumes 1–24, as held in `eko.db`. This chapter quotes the sixteenth- and early seventeenth-century texts; the editors' introductions and notes are cited as such where they matter.

**The rites covered.** "Extraordinary" here means every rite outside the ordinary Sunday and weekday services, what German liturgics calls the *Kasualien* and the episcopal acts. The chapter covers:

- the sacramental acts: baptism, exorcism, confirmation, marriage (with betrothal, its dissolution, divorce and annulment), private confession and absolution, extreme unction;
- the rites of passage around birth, sickness and death: churching, the visitation of the sick, funerals and burial;
- the acts of the ministry: ordination, installation of pastors and prelates, the consecration of bishops;
- the lay offices: elders, deacons, sextons, schoolmasters, cantors, churchwardens, midwives;
- civil offices: magistrates and oaths of homage;
- consecrations and blessings: churches, churchyards, altars, chrism, water, candles, palms, bells, wreaths;
- discipline: the lesser and greater ban, excommunication, public penance and the restoration of the penitent, the deposition of ministers;
- marks of the clerical and sacred state: the tonsure, the deconsecration of churches and vessels;
- processions;
- other occasional services, such as the parish visitation.

**Full liturgies and summaries.** Where an order prints a full rite, the chapter gives its order of service step by step and quotes its central texts: the formula of baptism, the vows, the prayers, the formula at the laying on of hands, the sentence of excommunication. Where many orders repeat one form, the chapter quotes the principal witness and lists the others. Where an order only mentions or abolishes a rite, the chapter summarizes it with a citation.

### 13.2.2 How the corpus was searched

Every document was scanned with regular expressions for the groups of terms below. Matches were read in context, and then the full passages were pulled from the relevant orders.

- **Baptism and exorcism.** *Tauf*, *Taufbüchlein*, *Nottaufe*, *Gevatter*, *Pate*, *exorcismus*, *beschweren*, *Westerhemd*, *Chresem*, *Chrisam*, *Salz*, *Speichel*, *Juden*.
- **Churching and confirmation.** *Sechswöchnerin*, *Kindbetterin*, *einleiten*, *einsegnen*, *aussegnen*, *Kirchgang*; *Firmung*, *Confirmation*, *Handauflegung*, *Katechismusverhör*.
- **Marriage.** *Trauung*, *zusammengeben*, *copuliren*, *Brautmesse*, *Aufgebot*, *proclamiren*, *Kranz*, *Kirchgang*, *Witwe*.
- **The sick and the dead.** *Kranke*, *Ölung*, *Sterbende*, *Pest*, *Gefangene*, *zum Tode verurteilt*, *Besessene*; *Begräbnis*, *Leiche*, *Leichpredigt*, *Vigilien*, *Seelmesse*, *Begängnis*, *Kirchhof*, *Gottesacker*.
- **Ministry.** *Ordination*, *ordiniren*, *Priesterweihe*, *Investitur*, *einweisen*, *installiren*, *praesentiren*, *Superintendent*, *Bischof*, *Prälat*; *Küster*, *Mesner*, *Opfermann*, *Schulmeister*, *Kantor*, *Organist*, *Kirchvater*, *Kastenherr*, *Hebamme*; *Senioren*, *Älteste*, *Diakon*.
- **Magistrates.** *Obrigkeit*, *Ratswahl*, *Ratspredigt*, *Huldigung*, *Erbhuldigung*.
- **Consecrations and blessings.** *Einweihung*, *Kirchweih*, *Kirmes*, *Kirchmesse*, *Kirbe*, *dedicatio*, *consecratio*; *weihen* and *segnen* with *Wasser*, *Salz*, *Kerzen*, *Licht*, *Palmen*, *Kräuter*, *Wurz*, *Feuer*, *Fladen*, *Eier*, *Wein*, *Johannissegen*; *Glocken*, *Glockentaufe*, *Wetterläuten*.
- **Betrothal, divorce, confession, unction.** *Verlöbnis*, *Ehegelübde*, *Eheversprechen*, *sponsalia*, *Handschlag*, *Weinkauf*, *ledig sprechen*, *Ehescheidung*, *divortium*, *Scheidebrief*, *impotentia*; *Beicht*, *Ohrenbeicht*, *Privatabsolution*, *Beichtgeld*; *Ölung*, *olye*, *unctio*, James 5.

- **Tonsure, profanation, deposition, processions.** *Platte*, *Tonsur*, *Krone scheren*; *profan*, *abbrechen* with *Altar* and *Kapelle*, *Kelch* and *Ornat* with *verkaufen*; *entsetzen*, *absetzen*, *degradieren*; *Procession*, *Kreuzgang*, *Umgang*, *circuitus*.
- **Discipline.** *Bann*, *kleiner* and *großer Bann*, *excommunicatio*, *dem Satan übergeben*, *ausschließen*, *abschneiden*, *öffentliche Buße*, *Kirchenbuße*, *Absolution*, *wieder aufnehmen*, *reconciliatio*.

**Related chapters.**

- Chapter 16 covers the minor orders, the diaconate, the eldership, sacristans, deaconesses and the religious, with the installation of each office (§13.12 here summarizes it).
- Chapter 17 covers the oaths and vows taken at ordination, installation and confirmation.
- Chapter 12 covers the closed seasons for weddings, the prayer and fast days, and the *Kirchweih* as a holiday.
- Chapter 6 covers the intercessions for magistrates, the sick and the dying.
- Chapter 11 covers wedding and funeral sermons.
- Chapter 8 covers the hymns sung at baptism, weddings and burials.
- Chapter 15 covers catechesis before confirmation and marriage, and the duties of the officers installed here (§§15.3–15.11).
- Chapter 14 covers the font, lights and vestments, and the image plays of the feasts (§§14.4.6, 14.5.6, 14.7).
- Chapter 9 covers bells for the dead and at baptisms and weddings (§§9.5.6–9.5.7).
- Chapter 3 covers general confession at the Mass and its relation to private confession (§3.4.6).
- Chapter 10 covers the Litany at the hours (§10.7.5).

#### 13.2.3 Cautions

- **Record headings and dates in the database.** A database record often holds more than one order, and its year field can be wrong. In this chapter every order is named from the running head of the page on which the quotation stands. Some examples:
  - The Henneberg record dated 1555 holds the *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst of 1582 and a consistory report of 1635.
  - The record for Müntzer's Allstedt text (Radical Reformation) is filed with the Saxon visitation of 1533.
  - The Grubenhagen order of 1581 is dated "1506" in the database.
  - The Solms record dated 1603 holds the discipline orders of 1582, 1584 and 1594.
  - The Danzig church order of 1612 stands in a record headed with the Danzig order of 1557.
  - The Schwäbisch Hall *Kirchenordnung* of 1543/1615 is split across records whose headings are taken from stray lines of the text ("Psalm oder ein Bußpsalm …", dated 1614).
- **Summaries by the editor.** Some rites survive only in Sehling's summary of a manuscript, such as the Merseburg ordination draft of 1545 (§13.10.3). These are marked as the editor's.
- **What the orders do not print.** The orders print what the church controlled. Civil oaths, coronations and the installation of magistrates were matters for the territorial and town constitutions and are mostly absent (§13.13). A missing rite is not proof that nothing was done.

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## 13.3 Baptism

The orders print more baptismal forms than forms for any other rite. They fall into four families, and nearly every form in the corpus can be placed in one of them:

- **The received rite in German.** These are translations of the Latin *ordo baptismi* with nearly all its ceremonies: Luther's *Taufbüchlein* of 1523, Nuremberg 1524, the Strasbourg German baptism of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) and the Ansbach "Würzburg rubrics" of 1526. Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 kept most of these ceremonies.
- **Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526.** This keeps the exorcism, the sign of the cross, the Flood prayer, the Gospel of the children, the renunciation and the threefold creed. It drops salt, spittle, oil, chrism and candle. It was taken into most Lutheran orders, often with an exhortation added before it and an address to the godparents after it.
- **The Upper German rite.** This is Strasbourg after 1525 (Moderate Reformed), Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 (Lutheran) and their many dependants. It has no exorcism and no sign of the cross. It is built from teaching, prayer, the Gospel and the creed, and the child is baptized by pouring.

- **The Reformed rite.** This is the Palatinate in 1563, the London strangers' church and the Lower Rhine. It is a covenant exhortation, a recast Flood prayer, the Lord's Prayer and the creed, a question to the parents, pouring and a thanksgiving. Emergency baptism by women is forbidden.

Exorcism, the point on which the families divided most sharply, is treated on its own in §13.4.

#### 13.3.1 What God instituted and what men added

The orders sort the ceremonies of baptism by one test: what Christ commanded, and what was added by human beings. What was added is then judged by whether it is free, useful or superstitious. Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 states the test most clearly. Prayer, the Gospel and godparents are kept. The blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle ("kot") are dropped. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 174):

> Nun hat Gott die tauf selbs eingesetzt und geordent, das man taufen soll mit wasser im namen des Vaters und des Suns und des Heiligen Gaists. So haben die menschen darzu getan aus aigner bewegung gebet, evangelion, gevattern, westerhembd, taufsegnen, öl, salz und kot etc. […] Das man nun gebet darbei spricht. und das heilig evangelion liset, ist nicht allein frei, sunder auch nütz und gut. Darumb soll mans lassen bleiben. Desgleichen auch die gevattern […] Aber das taufsegnen, öl, salz und kot verdunkeln mer die wesenlichen stück der tauf; dann sie fürdern und dienen nur zu aberglauben.

Now God hath Himself instituted and ordained baptism, that one shall baptize with water in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. To this men have added of their own motion prayer, gospel, godparents, chrisom-robe, the blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle, etc. […] Now that prayer be spoken withal, and the holy gospel read, is not only free, but also profitable and good. Therefore shall it be let remain. Likewise also the godparents […] But the blessing of the font, oil, salt and spittle darken rather the essential parts of baptism; for they further and serve only superstition.

Luther had made the same distinction in the epilogue to the *Taufbüchlein*, printed with both versions. The outward ceremonies are "the least" part of baptism. What matters is that the godparents stand in faith, hear the Word and pray in earnest. **Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*, 1523, epilogue** (Sehling 1, p. 20):

> So gedenke nu, das in dem teufen disse eusserliche stücke das geringste sind, als da ist, unter augen blasen, creuze an streichen, salz in den mund geben, speichel und kot in die oren und nasen thun, mit öle auf der brust und schuldern salben, und mit chresem die scheitel bestreichen, westerhemd anzihen, und brennend kerzen in die hend geben, und was das mehr ist, das von menschen die tauf zu zieren hinzu gethan ist. Denn auch wol on solchs alles die taufe geschehen mag, und nicht die • rechte griffe sind, die der teufel scheuet oder fleucht.

So consider now, that in baptizing these outward pieces are the least, as namely to breathe under the eyes, to sign with crosses, to put salt in the mouth, to put spittle and clay in the ears and nose, to anoint with oil on the breast and shoulders, and to smear the crown with chrism, to put on the chrisom-robe, and to give burning candles in the hand, and whatsoever more there is that hath been added by men to adorn baptism. For baptism may well be done without all such, and they are not the right grips that the devil feareth or fleeth.

#### 13.3.2 The received rite: Luther's *Taufbüchlein* of 1523

Luther's first German baptismal book translated the Wittenberg form of the Latin rite almost whole. Its order can stand for all the early German translations. Nuremberg in 1524, Strasbourg in 1524 (Moderate Reformed) and Ansbach in 1526 differ from it only in detail. Sehling 1, pp. 18–20:

1. **Exsufflation and first exorcism.** The minister breathes three times under the child's eyes: "Far aus, du unreiner geist, und gib raum dem heiligen geist" ("Depart, thou unclean spirit, and give place to the Holy Ghost").
2. **Sign of the cross** on forehead and breast.
3. **Two prayers.** The first is "O almechtiger ewiger gott … Du woltist sehen auf diesen N." ("O almighty everlasting God … look upon this N."). The second is "O gott, du unsterblicher trost aller die was fodern" ("O God, the immortal comfort of all that ask aught").
4. **Salt** is put in the mouth: "Nim N. das salz der weisheit" ("Take, N., the salt of wisdom").
5. **The Flood prayer** (*Sintflutgebet*), Luther's own composition (quoted in full in §13.3.3).

6. **Two exorcisms.** The first is "Darumb, du leidiger teufel, erkenne dein urteil" ("Therefore, thou wretched devil, acknowledge thy sentence"). The second is "Ich beschwere dich, du unreiner geist" ("I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit").
7. **A prayer for enlightenment**: "Herr heiliger vater, almechtiger ewiger got, von dem alle liecht der warheit komt" ("O Lord, holy Father, almighty everlasting God, from whom cometh all light of truth").
8. **The Gospel of the children**, Mark 10:13–16, with the greeting.
9. **The Lord's Prayer**, the priest laying his hands on the child's head and kneeling with the godparents.
10. **The *Ephphatha*.** Spittle is touched to the ears and nose, the child is led into the church, and the minister says "The Lord preserve thy going in and thy coming out".
11. **Renunciation and creed.** The threefold renunciation, then the threefold creed in question and answer.
12. **Anointing** with oil on the breast and between the shoulders.
13. **The question and the baptism.** "Wilt thou be baptized?", then immersion in the font with the Trinitarian formula.
14. **Chrism** on the crown, with the blessing "Der allmechtige got und vater unsers herrn Jhesu Christi, der dich ander weit geporn hatt" ("The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again").
15. **The white robe and the candle.** The hood or chrisom-robe is put on, and a burning candle is given into the hand.

The ceremonies after the Gospel, which Luther dropped three years later, read as follows. **Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht*, 1523** (Sehling 1, pp. 19–20):

> Darnach neme er mit dem finger speichel und rüre da mit das rechte ohr und sprech: Ephthah, das ist, thu dich auf. Zu der nasen und zum lincken ore: Du teufel aber fleuch, denn gotis gericht komt herbei. […] Darnach salbe er das kind mit heiligem öle auf der brust und zwischen den schuldern und sprech: Und ich salbe dich mit heilsamen ole in Jhesu Christo unserm herrn. Und frage: willtu getauft sein ? Antwort. Ja. Da neme er das kind und tauche es in die taufe, und sprech: Und ich teufe dich im namen des vaters und des sons und des heiligen geists. Denn sollen die paten das kindlin halten in der taufe, und der priester mache ihm ein creuz mit dem öle auf der scheitel […] Nim das weisse, heilige und unbefleckts kleid, das du on flecken bringen solt fur den richtstuel Christi, das du das ewige leben habst. Frid mit dir. Darnach heb man es aus der taufe und der priester geb ihm ein kerzen in die hand. Nim diese brennende fackel und beware dein taufe unstreflich, auf das, wenn der herr komt zur hochzeit, du ihm mugest entgegen gehen, sampt den heiligen in den himelischen saal, und das ewige leben habst, Amen.

Then let him take spittle with the finger and touch therewith the right ear and say: *Ephphatha*, that is, Be thou opened. To the nose and to the left ear: But thou, devil, flee, for God's judgement cometh near. […] Then let him anoint the child with holy oil on the breast and between the shoulders and say: And I anoint thee with saving oil in Jesus Christ our Lord. And let him ask: Wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yes. Then let him take the child and dip it in the font, and say: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Then shall the godparents hold the child in the font, and the priest make it a cross with the oil on the crown […] Take the white, holy and undefiled garment, which thou shalt bring without spot before the judgement seat of Christ, that thou mayest have eternal life. Peace be with thee. Then let it be lifted out of the font, and the priest give it a candle in the hand: Take this burning torch and keep thy baptism blameless, that when the Lord cometh to the wedding thou mayest go to meet him, together with the saints, into the heavenly hall, and have eternal life. Amen.

The other early translations kept still more. The Strasbourg German baptism of 1524 (Moderate Reformed) prints the blessing of the salt with its own exorcism, and four exorcisms of the child where Luther has two. **Strasbourg, the early agendas: the German baptism, 1524** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 124):

> Hie nach segnet man das saltz mit nachvolgenden worten: Ich beschwer dich, geschöpff des saltz, in dem namen Gottes [+], des almechtigen vatters, und in der liebe unsers herren Jesu Christi [+] und in der krafft des heiligen geist [+].

Hereafter the salt is blessed with the following words: I adjure thee, creature of salt, in the name of God [+], the almighty Father, and in the love of our Lord Jesus Christ [+] and in the power of the Holy Ghost [+].

**Brandenburg 1540: salt and chrism kept.** Electoral Brandenburg is the one territorial order that kept the old ceremonies on principle. Its baptism has the long prayers of 1523, the salt and the chrism, with a careful explanation. The chrism signifies the royal priesthood of Christians. It is not "of the substance" of baptism, and a child baptized in an emergency is not to be chrismed afterwards, lest the chrism seem necessary. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 54):

> Und weil denn auch insonderheit ein alte hergebrachte ceremonia, den chresem bei der tauf zu brauchen, wollen wir denselben nachmals auch im brauch bleiben lassen, aber doch sol die meinung desselben in nachfolgendem verstande sein. […] darneben aber sol gleichwol das volk gnugsam unterricht werden, das alleine der heilig geist in der tauf uns salbe und zu christen mache, und nicht der chresem, der solchs nur ein bedeutung ist, das auch diejenigen, so gleich mit chresem nicht gesalbet, nichts minder volkomene christen, und inen des gar nicht schedlich sei, darumb auch unnötig die kinder, so in der eil und not von weibern oder sonst getauft, dieselben hernacher zu chresemen, denn so würde es als notwendig angesehen.

And because there is in particular an old received ceremony, to use the chrism at baptism, we will let the same still remain in use, but yet the meaning of it shall be in the understanding following. […] but therewithal the people shall nevertheless be sufficiently taught that only the Holy Ghost anointeth us in baptism and maketh us Christians, and not the chrism, which is only a signification of it; that those also who are not anointed with chrism are none the less perfect Christians, and it is no hurt to them at all; therefore also [it is] needless to chrism afterwards the children that have been baptized in haste and need by women or otherwise, for so it would be regarded as necessary.

**The anointings in the Brandenburg rite.** The Brandenburg baptism has both medieval anointings. After the renunciation and the threefold creed the priest anoints the child with the oil of catechumens on the breast and between the shoulders. After the baptism and the prayer "Der allmechtig gott" he anoints the crown of the head with chrism in the form of a cross, while the godparents take their hands away. The white cap (*Westerhäublein*) and the burning candle follow. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 58–59):

> Darauf ungirt der priester das kind an der brust und zwischen den schultern mit dem öl cathecuminorum und spricht: So salbe ich dich mit dem öl der freuden in Christo † Jesu. Und bald nimmt der priester das kind in seine hende, halte es uber den taufstein, salbe es zwischen den schultern und spreche: Unserm herrn. Bald darauf frage er, wie das kind heiss und spreche: N. Wil du getauft werden. Antwort: Ja, ich will. Da neme er das kind abermal und spreche: Und ich taufe dich im namen des vaters und des sons und des heiligen geists. Darnach treten die paten hinzu, halten das kind uber den taufbrun und der priester spricht: Last uns beten. Der allmechtig gott und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, der dich anderweit geborn hat durchs wasser und den heiligen geist, und hat dir all dein sund vergeben, Da ungirt der priester das getauft kind mit dem Chresem auf der schetteln creuzweis, und die paten thun ire hende ab, so spricht der priester: Derselbig salbe dich mit dem chresem seins heils † zum ewigen leben, amen. Der fried sei mit dir und mit deinem geist. Darnach ruren die paten das kind an, und der priester setzt dem kinde das westerheublein auf und spricht: Nim hin das weisse kleid, welches da bedeutet die unschuld, so du in der tauf empfangen hast, dasselbe solt du on makel fur den richterstul Jesu Christi bringen, auf das du habest durch das verdienstnis Jesu Christi das ewig leben. Der fried sei mit dir und mit deinem geist. Alsdenn hebt man das kind vom taufbrun, und wenn das geschehen ist, so gibt der priester dem kind ein brennend kerzen, welche auch die paten angreifen und spricht: Nim hin die brinnend fackel, die da bedeut das licht des christlichen glaubens, welchen du in der tauf itzt empfangen und angelobet hast, und beware dein tauf unstreflich, auf das, wenn der herr zur hochzeit komen wird, du im entgegen laufen mögst mit sampt den heiligen in den himlischen saal, das du in Christo Jesu habst das ewig leben, amen.

Thereupon the priest anointeth the child on the breast and between the shoulders with the oil of catechumens, and saith: So I anoint thee with the oil of gladness in Christ † Jesus. And straightway the priest taketh the child in his hands, holdeth it over the font, anointeth it between the shoulders, and saith: Our Lord. Soon thereafter he asketh what the child is called, and saith: N., wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yea, I will. Then he taketh the child again and saith: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Thereafter the godparents come near and hold the child over the font, and the priest saith: Let us pray. The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again by water and the Holy Ghost, and hath forgiven thee all thy sins — Then the priest anointeth the baptized child with the chrism on the crown of the head crosswise, and the godparents take away their hands, and the priest saith: The same anoint thee with the chrism of his salvation † unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit. Thereafter the godparents touch the child, and the priest setteth the chrisom-cap upon the child and saith: Take the white garment, which signifieth the innocence which thou hast received in baptism; the same shalt thou bring without spot before the judgement-seat of Jesus Christ, that thou mayest have eternal life through the merit of Jesus Christ. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit. Then the child is lifted from the font, and when that is done the priest giveth the child a burning candle, which the godparents also take hold of, and saith: Take the burning torch, which signifieth the light of the Christian faith which thou hast now received and vowed in baptism, and keep thy baptism unblameable, that when the Lord cometh to the marriage thou mayest run to meet him with all the saints into the heavenly hall, that thou mayest have eternal life in Christ Jesus. Amen.

**Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.** Pfalz-Neuburg copied the Brandenburg rite, with its defence of the chrism (Sehling 13, pp. 46–47), word for word in its substance. Its anointings read: **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 55):

> Darauf salbet der priester das kind mit dem oleo catechumenorum erstlich an der brust und spricht: So salbe ich dich mit dem öle der freuden in Christo † Jesu. Und alsbald nimpt der priester das kind in seine hend und helt es uber den taufstein und salbet es auch zwischen den schultern und spricht: Unserm † Herren. […] Da salbet der priester das getauft kind mit dem chresem auf der scheitel kreuzweis und die doten tun ire hend ab und er spricht: Derselbig salbe dich mit dem chresem des heils zum ewigen leben! Amen. Der frid sei mit dir und mit deinem geist! Darnach rüren die doten das kind wider an und der priester setzt im das westerheublin auf

Thereupon the priest anointeth the child with the oil of catechumens, first on the breast, and saith: So I anoint thee with the oil of gladness in Christ † Jesus. And straightway the priest taketh the child in his hands and holdeth it over the font, and anointeth it also between the shoulders, and saith: Our † Lord. […] Then the priest anointeth the baptized child with the chrism on the crown crosswise, and the godparents take away their hands, and he saith: The same anoint thee with the chrism of salvation unto everlasting life! Amen. Peace be with thee and with thy spirit! Thereafter the godparents touch the child again, and the priest setteth the chrisom-cap upon it

Pfalz-Neuburg gives no candle. Its chrism did not last: Ottheinrich suspended the chrism section and issued a new baptismal order (Sehling 13, p. 22, editor's note; §13.15.4).

The same order has the salt: "N. nim hin das salz der weisheit, das du in Christo Jesu, unserm herrn, habst das ewig leben" ("N., take the salt of wisdom, that thou mayest have eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord"; Sehling 3, p. 56). Brandenburg-Nürnberg had already ruled against the oil in 1528, because it was given "in the meaning" that the child was thereby anointed with the Holy Ghost. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 135):

> Und wiewol es scheinet, als sollte die kinder mit öl zu salben, frei sein, so ists doch nit frei, das kind der mainung zu salben, das es also mit dem H. Gaist gesalbet werde: dann Got hats nit gehaissen noch zugesagt, das er sein Gaist woll eben dahin geben, da man mit dem öl salbe. Dweil es aber von bebstischen der meinung aufgesetzt ist, soll mans auch fallen lassen, desgleichen das salz, spaicheln und kot.

And although it seemeth as though to anoint the children with oil should be free, yet it is not free to anoint the child in the meaning that it be thereby anointed with the Holy Ghost: for God hath neither bidden nor promised that he will give his Spirit just there where one anointeth with oil. But since it was set up by the papists in that meaning, it shall be let fall, likewise the salt, spittle and clay.

### 13.3.3 Luther's revised *Taufbüchlein* of 1526: the Lutheran standard

In 1526 Luther reissued the book shortened. Sehling's headnote lists the orders that took it over: Göttingen 1530, Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, Northeim 1539, Duke Henry's Saxon agenda 1539, Halle 1541, Schleswig-Holstein 1542, Pomerania 1542, Schweinfurt 1543, Ritzebüttel 1544 and Mecklenburg 1552 (Sehling 1, p. 21). The whole rite is short enough to give entire. **Luther, *Das taufbuchlin verdeudscht aufs neu zu gericht*, 1526** (Sehling 1, pp. 22–23):

> Der taufer spreche: Far aus, du unreiner geist, und gib raum dem heiligen geist. Darnach mach er ihm ein creuz an die stirn und brust und spreche: Nim das zeichen des heiligen creuzs, beide an der stirn und an der brust. Last uns beten. O almechtiger ewiger gott, vater unsers herrn Jhesu Christi. Ich rufe dich an uber diesen N., deinen diener, der deiner taufe gabe bittet und dein ewige gnade durch die geistliche wider gepurt begerd. Nim ihn auf, HERRE, und wie du gesagt hast ‘Bittet, so werdet ihr nehmen, sucht, so werdet ihr finden, klopfet an, so wird euch aufgethan’, so reiche nu das gut dem der da bittet, und offen die thur dem der da anklopfet: das er den ewigen segen dieses himelischen bades erlange und das verheissen reich deiner gabe entpfahe, durch Christum, unsern herrn. Amen. Last uns beten. Almechtiger ewiger gott, der du hast durch die sindflut nach deinem gestrengen gericht die ungleubige welt verdamt und den gleubigen Noe selb acht nach deiner grossen barmherzigkeit erhalten, und den verstockten Pharao mit allen seinen im roten meer erseuft, und dein volk Israel trocken durch hin gefurt, da mit dis bad deiner heiligen taufe zukunftig bezeichnet, und durch die taufe deines lieben kindes, unsers herren Jhesu Christi den Jordan und alle wasser zur seligen sindflut und reichlicher abwaschung der sunden geheiliget und eingesetzt: Wir bitten durch die selbe deine grundlose barmherzickeit, du woltest disen N. gnediglich ansehen und mit rechtem glauben im geist beseligen, das durch dise heilsame sindflut an ihm ersaufe und untergehe alles, was ihm von Adam angeporn ist, und er selb dazu gethan hat; und er aus der

> ungleubigen zal gesundert, in der heiligen arca der christenheit trocken und sicher behalten, alzeit brunstig im geist, frolich in hoffnung, deinem namen diene, auf das er mit allen gleubigen deiner verheissung ewigs lebens zu erlangen wirdig werde, durch Jhesum Christum unsern herrn. Amen. Ich beschwere dich, du unreiner geist, bei dem namen des vaters † und des sons † und des heiligen geists †, das du aus farest und weichest von disem diener Jhesu Christi .N. Amen. Last uns hören das heilig evangelion S. Marcus. Zu der zeit brachten sie kindlin zu Jhesu, das er sie solt anrüren. Aber die iunger bedraueten die so sie brachten. Da das Jhesus sahe, verdros ihn und sprach zu ihn: Last die kindlin zu mir komen und weret ihn nicht, denn solcher ist das himelreich. Warlich ich sage euch, wer nicht das reich gottis nimpt wie ein kindlin, der wird nicht hinein komen. Und er herzet sie und leget die hende auf sie und segnet sie. Denn lege der priester seine hende aufs kinds heubt und bete das Vater unser samt den paten nider geknihet. […] Darnach leite man das kindlin zu der taufe und der priester spreche: Der herr behüte deinen eingang und ausgang von nu an bis zu ewigen zeiten. Darnach lass der priester das kind durch seine paten dem teufel absagen und spreche: N. Entsagestu dem teufel? Antwort: Ja. Und alle seinen wercken? Antwort: Ja. Und alle seinem wesen? Antwort: Ja. Darnach frage er: Gleubestu an got den almechtigen vater, schepfer himels und erden? Antwort: Ja. Gleubestu an Jhesum Christ seinen einigen sohn, unsern herrn, geporn und gelitten? Antwort: Ja. Gleubestu an den heiligen geist, ein heilige christliche kirche, gemeine der heiligen, vergebung der sunde, auferstehung des fleischs, und nach dem tod ein ewiges leben? Antwort: Ja. Wiltu getaufft sein? Antwort: Ja. Da neme er das kind und tauche es in die taufe und spreche: Und ich teufe dich im namen des vaters und des sons und des heiligen geistes. Denn sollen die paten des kindlin halten in der taufe, und der priester spreche, weil er das westerhemd an zeucht: Der almechtige gott und vater unsers herrn Jhesu Christi, der dich anderweit geporn hat durchs wasser und den heiligen geist, und hat dir alle deine sunde vergeben, der sterke dich mit seiner gnade zum ewigen leben. Amen. Frid mit dir. Antwort: Amen.

Let the baptizer say: Depart, thou unclean spirit, and give place to the Holy Ghost. Then let him make a cross on its forehead and breast and say: Receive the sign of the holy cross, both on the forehead and on the breast. Let us pray. O almighty everlasting God, Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, I call upon thee for this N., thy servant, who asketh the gift of thy baptism and desireth thy everlasting grace through the spiritual new birth. Receive him, O LORD, and as thou hast said, "Ask, and ye shall receive; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you", so give now the good thing to him that asketh, and open the door to him that knocketh: that he may obtain the everlasting blessing of this heavenly washing and receive the promised kingdom of thy gift, through Christ our Lord. Amen. Let us pray. Almighty everlasting God, who by the flood didst according to thy strict judgement condemn the unbelieving world, and according to thy great mercy didst preserve believing Noah, himself the eighth, and didst drown hardened Pharaoh with all his in the Red Sea, and didst lead thy people Israel through dry, thereby signifying beforehand this washing of thy holy baptism, and by the baptism of thy dear Child, our Lord Jesus Christ, didst hallow and ordain Jordan and all waters to be a blessed flood and an abundant washing away of sins: we pray through the same thy bottomless mercy, that thou wouldest graciously look upon this N. and bless him with right faith in the spirit, that by this saving flood there may be drowned in him and go under all that is born in him from Adam, and that he himself hath added thereto; and that he, being severed from the number of the unbelieving, kept dry and safe in the holy ark of Christendom, may serve thy name always fervent in spirit, joyful in hope, that with all the faithful he may be made worthy to obtain thy promise of everlasting life, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen. I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit, in the name of the Father † and of the Son † and of the Holy Ghost †, that thou come out and depart from this servant of Jesus Christ, N. Amen. Let us hear the holy gospel of Saint Mark. At that time they brought young children to Jesus, that he should touch them. But the disciples rebuked those that brought them. When Jesus saw it, he was much displeased, and said unto them: Suffer the little children to come unto me, and forbid them not, for of such is the kingdom of heaven. Verily I say unto you, whosoever shall not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, he shall not enter therein. And he took them up in his arms, and put his hands upon them, and blessed them. Then let the priest lay his hands on the child's head and pray the Our Father together with the godparents, kneeling. […] Then let the child be led to the font and the priest say: The Lord preserve thy going in and thy coming out from this time forth for evermore. Then let the priest cause the child through its godparents to renounce the devil, and say: N., renouncest thou the devil? Answer: Yes. And all his works? Answer: Yes. And all his ways? Answer: Yes. Then let him ask: Believest thou in God the Father almighty, maker of heaven and earth? Answer: Yes. Believest thou in Jesus Christ his only Son our Lord, born and suffered? Answer: Yes. Believest thou in the Holy Ghost, one holy Christian church, the communion of saints, forgiveness of sins, resurrection of the flesh, and after death an everlasting life? Answer: Yes. Wilt thou be baptized? Answer: Yes. Then let him take the child and dip it in the font and say: And I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Then shall the godparents hold the child in the font, and the priest say, while he putteth on the chrisom-robe: The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again through water and the Holy Ghost, and hath forgiven thee all thy sins, strengthen thee with his grace unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee. Answer: Amen.

The 1526 order thus keeps:

- one exorcism at the door ("Far aus") and one before the Gospel ("Ich beschwere dich");
- the sign of the cross;
- the prayer "Nim ihn auf" ("Receive him") and the Flood prayer;
- Mark 10 and the Lord's Prayer with the laying on of hands;
- the procession to the font with Psalm 121:8;
- the threefold renunciation and the threefold creed, answered by the godparents in the child's name;
- "Wilt thou be baptized?", immersion, the *Westerhemd* and the closing blessing.

It drops salt, spittle, oil, chrism, candle and the second set of prayers and exorcisms.

#### 13.3.4 The Saxon agenda and Brandenburg-Nürnberg: exhortations around Luther's rite

The territorial agendas did not change Luther's 1526 text, but framed it with teaching.

**Saxony 1539.** Duke Henry's agenda opens with an exhortation to "those who bring children to baptism". It sets out original sin and Christ's command to bring the children to him, and asks the bystanders to "help to pray". Then comes Luther's rite. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 266):

> Auf nachfolgende weise sollen die pfarherr, die leute, so kinder zur tauf tragen, anreden und vermanen. Lieben freunde in Christo, wir hören alle tage aus gottes wort, erfarens auch, beide an unserm leben und sterben, das wir von Adam her, allesampt in sünden empfangen und geborn werden, darinnen wir denn unter gottes zorn in ewigkeit verdampt und verloren sein müssen, wo uns nicht durch den eingebornen gottes son, unsern lieben herrn Jesum Christum daraus geholfen were. […] derhalben so wollet aus christlicher liebe dieses gegenwertigen armen kindlins gegen gott dem herrn, euch mit ernst auch annemen, dasselbige dem herrn Christo furtragen umb vergebung der sünden, und das es ins reichder gnaden und seligkeit auch aufgenomen werden möge, vorbitten helfen.

In the manner following shall the pastors address and exhort the people that bear children to baptism. Dear friends in Christ, we hear every day out of God's word, and find it also, both in our life and in our dying, that from Adam onward we are all conceived and born in sins, wherein we must be under God's wrath condemned and lost for ever, if we were not helped out of them by the only-begotten Son of God, our dear Lord Jesus Christ. […] therefore of Christian love take earnestly upon you also the cause of this present poor little child before God the Lord, bear it to the Lord Christ, and help to pray for the forgiveness of sins, and that it may be received also into the kingdom of grace and salvation.

The editions from 1540 and from 1555 (Sehling's A and B) add two things. One is a short sermon on the Gospel "if there be time and the child is not weak". The other is a long address to the godparents before the renunciation, binding them to see the child taught the commandments, creed and Lord's Prayer. It ends with the godparents' "yes" and the minister's "Das verleihe uns unser lieber herr gott und erfülle mit seinen gnaden, das wir nicht vermögen" ("This grant us our dear Lord God, and fulfil with his grace what we are not able"; Sehling 1, p. 267). Both may be left out "where it would be too long or the child is weak".

**Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533.** The Franconian order recast Luther's 1526 epilogue as a spoken admonition: "Ir allerliebsten! Ich vermane und bitt euch alle …" ("Dearly beloved! I exhort and pray you all …"; Sehling 11, p. 178). It then gave Luther's rite with the full Apostles' Creed in the second question. It added a charge to the godparents after the baptism, which many later orders copied. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 180):

> Nach der tauf sollen die pfarherr oder kirchendiener die gevattern ermanen ungeferlich auf die weise: Ich verman euch in kraft der christenlichen liebe, die ir jetzo an des kindleins stat bei der tauf geton habt, wann es seiner eltern durch tods- oder andern unfal beraubt würde, ehe dann es zum brauch seiner vernunft köme, das irs fleißig und treulich wolt unterrichten und leren erstlich die zehen gepot, auf das es den willen Gottes und seine sünd dardurch lerne erkennen, darnach den christlichen glauben, durch welichen wir gnad, vergebung der sünde und den Heiligen Gaist empfahen, zuletzt auch das Vater unser, damit es Gott anrufen und hilf bitten könne, dem Satan widerstand zu tun und christlich zu leben, bis Gott an ime erfüllet, was er jetzo in der tauf angefangen hat, und es selig werde.

After the baptism shall the pastors or ministers of the church exhort the godparents somewhat after this manner: I exhort you, by virtue of the Christian love which ye have now shown in the child's stead at the baptism, that if it should be bereaved of its parents by death or other mishap before it come to the use of its reason, ye will diligently and faithfully instruct it and teach it

first the ten commandments, that it may thereby learn to know the will of God and its sin; then the Christian faith, through which we receive grace, forgiveness of sins and the Holy Ghost; lastly also the Our Father, that it may call upon God and pray for help to withstand Satan and to live as a Christian, until God fulfil in it what he hath now begun in baptism, and it be saved.

#### 13.3.5 The Upper German rite: Strasbourg and Württemberg

**Württemberg 1536.** Brenz's first Württemberg order kept Luther's spoken admonition, the prayer "Nim ihn auf", the Flood prayer, the Gospel and the Lord's Prayer. It has no exorcism and no sign of the cross, and it does not have the renunciation or the creed. There is one question to those who bring the child, and the child is sprinkled three times. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 113):

> Darnach trage man das kindlin zu dem Tauff und der priester frage diejhenigen, so das kind herzu tragen haben, auff die meynung: Ir aller liebsten, ir begeren, das dis kind auff Christum Jesum getaufft und durch das eusserlich zeichen des tauffs seiner heiligen gemein eingeleibt werde. Darauff sollen sie antworten: Ja. Als dann nimpt er das kind und besprengt es drey mal mit wasser und spricht: N., ich tauff dich in namen des vatters und des suns und des heyligen geists; und sprech darauff: Der allmechtig Gott und vatter unsers herren Jesu Christi, der dich anderwerts geborn hat durchs wasser und den heyligen geist unnd hat dir alle deine sünd vergeben, der sterck dich mit seiner gnad zum ewigen leben, Amen. Der frid sey mit dir, Amen.

Then let the child be borne to the font and the priest ask those that have borne the child thither, to this effect: Dearly beloved, ye desire that this child be baptized into Christ Jesus and be incorporated into his holy congregation through the outward sign of baptism. Thereto shall they answer: Yes. Then he taketh the child and sprinkleth it three times with water and saith: N., I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost; and let him say thereupon: The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath begotten thee again through water and the Holy Ghost and hath forgiven thee all thy sins, strengthen thee with his grace unto everlasting life. Amen. Peace be with thee. Amen.

**Württemberg 1553.** The great order of 1553 became the form of the south-west. Sehling's apparatus records its baptism in the Baden orders of 1556 and 1598 and in Mömpelgard in 1560 and 1571, and Nassau-Weilburg in 1576 opens its baptism with the same words. Its order is:

1. The name is asked, and whether the child was baptized in an emergency.
2. **An opening address** (*Form des Tauffs*): a child is brought "to be commended to the prayer of the common Christian church".
3. **The Gospel of the children** (Mark 10), read first.
4. **An exhortation** on original sin and Christ's love for children.
5. **Two prayers**: "Nim ihn auf", and the Flood prayer as an alternative (*Ein ander Gebett*).
6. **The Lord's Prayer.**
7. Psalm 121:8 over the child.
8. **An address to the godparents**: whoever joins the church "entereth a spiritual battle".
9. **Renunciation** in one question, and **the Apostles' Creed** in three questions.
10. "Wilt thou be baptized thereon?"
11. **Pouring** on the unwrapped child, "with clear, loud and distinct voice".
12. **The blessing** "Der Allmechtig Gott".
13. **A thanksgiving prayer**, then **an admonition** to parents, kin and godparents to bring the child to the catechism.

The rubric on the mode of baptism declares immersion, pouring and sprinkling all indifferent. It then orders pouring on the naked child, except in cold weather or weakness. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, pp. 232–233):

> Das aber das Kind im Tauffen inn- oder auß gewickelt, ein- oder drey mal begossen, in das wasser eingedaucht oder mit wasser besprengt werde, ist an im selbs mittelmässig. Jedoch, dieweil in der kirchen alles ordenlich und zur besserung gesche hen soll, haben wir für nutzlich bedacht, das die kindlin außgewickelt, doch, allerlei gefahr zuverhüten, nicht ins Wasser gedaucht, sonder mit dem wasser also nackend begossen werden, es were dann sach, das das Kind so schwach, das es den lufft oder kelte nicht wol leiden möchte, als dann mage es eingewickelt wol getaufft werden.

But that the child in baptizing be wrapped or unwrapped, poured upon once or three times, dipped into the water or sprinkled with water, is in itself indifferent. Yet, since in the church all things should be done orderly and to edifying, we have thought it

profitable that the children be unwrapped, yet, to prevent all manner of danger, not dipped into the water, but poured upon with the water naked as they are, unless it be that the child be so weak that it could not well bear the air or the cold; then it may well be baptized wrapped.

**Strasbourg 1537** (Moderate Reformed). Strasbourg had moved furthest from the old rite. Its agenda sets fixed times for baptism: in the Minster on Sundays after the noon sermon and on Wednesdays after the morning sermon, and in the other parishes at Sunday vespers. The service is a sermon in brief, with four heads of exhortation. Then come silent prayer, two prayers, the Gospel, the creed said by all, an address to the whole congregation and the godparents, threefold pouring, a thanksgiving and a dismissal. There is no exorcism, no cross and no question to the godparents. The words at the font are these. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 269):

> Uff dises begeret der Diener im das kindlin nach ordnung darzu geben. Das nimet er dan in seine hend, entplösset es und als er gefraget, wie es heissen solle, nennet er es mit seinem namen, begeusset es dristet und sagt: N., Ich teuffe dich im namen des Vatters und des Suns und des heiligen Geists, Amen. […] Geht hin im friden. Der Herre gebe, das seine heiligen Engel, die sein angesicht sehen im himel, dis kind (dise kindlin) vor allem argen zu allem guten bewaren und fürderen, Amen.

Hereupon the minister desireth the child to be given him in order. This he then taketh in his hands, uncovereth it, and when he hath asked what it shall be called, nameth it with its name, poureth upon it thrice and saith: N., I baptize thee in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. […] Go hence in peace. The Lord grant that his holy angels, which see his face in heaven, may keep this child (these children) from all evil and further it unto all good. Amen.

### 13.3.6 The Reformed rite: the Palatinate 1563

The Reformed Palatine order of 1563 drew its baptism from Zurich, Geneva, Frankfurt and the London strangers' church (all Reformed) (Sehling's notes, Sehling 14, pp. 337–341). It begins with the *adjutorium* "Unser hilf stehet im namen des herrn". There follows a long exhortation on the three names: the Father as the covenant God of us and our seed, the Son as Saviour, the Spirit as teacher and comforter. The children's right to baptism is drawn from the covenant with Abraham and from Mark 10. Then come:

- the Flood prayer, recast so that the waters "signify" baptism and the child is asked to be "engrafted" into Christ;
- the Lord's Prayer;
- the Apostles' Creed, said "with me" by all;
- one question to the parents and godparents;
- the uncovering of the head only;
- pouring with the formula;
- a thanksgiving and a charge to the parents and godparents.

There is no exorcism, no renunciation by the godparents in the child's name, no sign of the cross and no *Westerhemd*. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 340):

> Frag. Begeret ir dann auß warem glauben an die verheissung Gottes in Jesu Christo, welche uns und unsern kindern gegeben ist, daß er nit allein unser, sonder auch unsers samens Gott sein wölle bis ins tausendt glid, daß dises kind darauf getauft werde und die versiglung der kindschaft Gottes empfahe ? Antwort. Ja. Hie ist unvonnöten, das kind aufzuwicklen, sonder genug, daß im das haupt entblösset werde. Und alsdann sage der kirchendiener, daß sie das kind nennen, und darnach begiesse er es mit wasser und sprech: N., ich tauf dich in dem namen Gottes, des vaters, des sohns und des heiligen geistes.

Question. Do ye then desire, out of true faith in the promise of God in Jesus Christ which is given to us and to our children, that he will be not only our God but also the God of our seed unto the thousandth generation, that this child be baptized thereupon and receive the sealing of the adoption of God? Answer: Yes. Here it is not needful to unwrap the child, but enough that its head be uncovered. And then let the minister of the church bid them name the child, and thereafter let him pour water upon it and say: N., I baptize thee in the name of God, the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost.

The same order reserves baptism to ministers of the Word and forbids baptism by any person "to whom the office of preaching is forbidden". This was directed, Sehling notes, against the emergency baptism allowed in the Palatine order of 1556. It requires

baptism in the assembled congregation, the presence of the father and the keeping of a baptismal register. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 337):

> In diesen worten befilcht der herr Christus denen allein zu taufen, so sein heyliges wort zu predigen berufen seind, und fast also beyde, das predigen und taufen, in einen bevelch und ampt zusammen. Derhalben keiner creatur gebürt, disen bevelch zu trennen und einer person das taufen zuzulassen, der das predigtampt verboten ist. Derhalben so sollen die kinder zu jeder gebürlicher zeit, so es von irentwegen ordentlich begeret und sie in die kirchen für die diener des worts gebracht, von den predigern getauft werden. Und solches soll fürnemlich geschehen auf Sontag, feiertag oder sonst in der wochen, wann die gemein Gottes beyeinander, auf daß sich ein jeder seins taufs wisse zu erinnern und die christlich gemein einhelliglich den namen Gottes uber das kind anrufe.

In these words the Lord Christ commandeth those only to baptize who are called to preach his holy Word, and so bindeth both, preaching and baptizing, together in one commandment and office. Therefore it behoveth no creature to sunder this commandment and to allow baptizing to a person to whom the office of preaching is forbidden. Therefore shall the children, at every fit time when it is orderly desired on their behalf and they are brought into the church before the ministers of the Word, be baptized by the preachers. And this shall be done chiefly on Sunday, holy day or otherwise in the week when the congregation of God is gathered, that every one may know to remember his baptism, and the Christian congregation with one accord call upon the name of God over the child.

#### 13.3.7 Emergency baptism and its confirmation in church

Every Lutheran order allowed baptism in danger of death by the midwife or any Christian. All forbade rebaptism "under condition", and most printed a form for receiving the child in church if it lived. This is the *Bestätigung der Nottaufe*, later called "confirmation of emergency baptism". The Saxon form of 1539 was the model, taken word for word into Brandenburg 1540 and many others. The pastor asks five questions:

1. Was the child brought to Christ and baptized?
2. By whom, and who was present?
3. Did you call upon God and pray?
4. With what did you baptize?
5. With what words?

If the answers are sure, he declares the baptism right, reads Mark 10 and prays the closing blessing of the rite. If they are unsure, the child is baptized "as unbaptized", without condition. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, pp. 267–268):

> So frage er weiter. Womit habt ir getauft? Antwortet man denn. Mit wasser. So frage er. Mit was worten habt ir getauft? So man denn sagt. Ich teufe dich im namen des vaters, und des sons, und des heiligen geists. So frage er endlich. Wisset ir, das ir der wort nach dem befel Christi gebraucht habt? Und wo sie darauf antworten. Ja wir wissens. So sagt er. Nu meine lieben freund, weil ir denn im namen und auf den befel unsers lieben herr gottes, solchs alles gethan, so sage ich, das ir recht und wol gethan habt […] Würden aber die leute, so das kindlin zu der tauf bringen, auf des pfarers frage ungewis antwort geben, und sagen, sie wüsten nicht was sie gedacht, viel weniger was sie geredt oder gethan in solcher grosser not (als denn oftmals zu geschehen pflegt) so mache man nicht viel disputirens, sondern neme das kind, als ungetauft, und forder es zur tauf, also wie man alle ungetaufte zur tauf zu fordern und zu teufen pflegt.

Then let him ask further: Wherewith did ye baptize? If they answer: With water, then let him ask: With what words did ye baptize? If they then say: I baptize thee in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost, then let him ask lastly: Know ye that ye used the words according to the command of Christ? And if they answer thereto: Yes, we know it, then he saith: Now, my dear friends, since ye have done all this in the name and by the command of our dear Lord God, I say that ye have done right and well […] But if the people that bring the child to baptism should give uncertain answer to the pastor's question, and say they knew not what they thought, much less what they said or did in such great need (as is then wont often to happen), let there be no great disputing, but let the child be taken as unbaptized and brought forward to baptism, as all the unbaptized are wont to be brought forward and baptized.

Württemberg in 1536 required the midwife to call two or three witnesses. Brandenburg-Nürnberg in its 1591 revision added a question that betrays the old practice of baptism in the womb: "Ob das kind vollkommlich geboren und ganz ledig von der

mutter gewesen, als man es getaufet?" ("Whether the child was fully born and quite free of the mother when it was baptized?"; Sehling 11, p. 181). For "no child shall be baptized in emergency that is not wholly born into the world."

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1528 asked that strong children wait for the next feast day, "that such baptism take place in the presence of so much the more people". In danger they were to be brought at once or baptized at home. Later orders set limits: three days (Schulenburg 1572), eight days (Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1557; Leiningen 1584). The Reformed Palatinate in 1563, as above, abolished emergency baptism by laypeople outright.

#### 13.3.8 Godparents, feasts and registers

**Number and quality.** The orders limited the number of godparents and excluded the openly wicked. Württemberg 1553 forbade "frivolous persons, who are bound in public vices without repentance" (Sehling 16, p. 233). The Palatinate 1563 (Reformed) had the father consult the minister in advance about the godparents (Sehling 14, p. 338). Breslau held to a rule, confirmed by the council eighty years before, of three godparents only (Sehling 3, p. 402). Duke August's Saxon order set the same limit under a fine of a hundred gulden. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 426):

> so sollen hinfüro nicht mehr denn drei gevattern, bei aufgesetzter straf ein hundert gülden, welche wir hiemit wiederumb erneuert haben wollen, gebeten, und hierüber niemands zugelassen werden.

so shall henceforth no more than three godparents be bidden, under the penalty laid of a hundred gulden, which we will hereby have renewed, and none be admitted above this.

**The christening feast.** The *Kindtaufe* meal was regulated with the wedding. Sarcerius's Mansfeld visitation form of 1554 lists, among the faults to be punished, more than three godparents, more than eight women at the meal, and men at the meal at all. **Mansfeld, *Form und weise einer visitation*, 1554** (Sehling 2, p. 192):

> Nicht mehr denn drei gefattern zum kindtauf bitten. Das nicht mehr denn acht weiber bei dem kindtauf essen sollen. Das keine menner in die kindtaufe gehen, alda zu essen oder zu trinken.

Not to bid more than three godparents to the christening. That not more than eight women shall eat at the christening. That no men go to the christening to eat or drink there.

**Registers.** The Palatinate in 1563 (Reformed) ordered the minister to enter "the name of the father, the mother, the child and the godparents" in a book kept at every church (Sehling 14, p. 338). Pfalz-Veldenz did the same in its Lützelstein order of 1605 (Sehling 18, p. 596).

The vows asked of godparents are treated in Chapter 17, §17.17.4.

#### 13.3.9 The baptism of adults and of Jews

The rite assumed infants. The orders made room for adults in three ways:

- **A clause in the Flood prayer.** Luther's words "and that he himself hath added thereto" (*und er selb dazugethan hat*) were marked in Württemberg as the clause to add "when an older person is baptized" (Sehling 16, pp. 112, 234).
- **The Hessian catechumenate.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) described the ancient catechumenate at length. Its section on baptism was taken into the Austrian agenda of 1571 as "a short Christian instruction for baptizing older persons" (Sehling 8, p. 268). In the ancient church, it says, the instructed made their confession "before the whole congregation on certain appointed feasts". They renounced the devil, confessed the creed and were baptized "in and before the whole church, which looked on".
- **Separate forms for Jews.** Sehling notes a liturgical form for the baptism of an adult Jew among the Mainz possessions, "perhaps the first in the evangelical church" (Sehling 2, p. 365). He prints a Friedberg *Judentaufformular* of about 1600. There the baptism followed catechetical instruction and examination and was done in the service of the congregation (Sehling 9, pp. 625, 635–637).

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### 13.4 Exorcism

The orders mean three different things by exorcism:

- the **baptismal exorcism**: the "Far aus" at the door, and the adjurations "Ich beschwere dich" in the rite (§13.3);
- the **exorcisms of creatures**: the exorcisms of salt and water in the blessing of holy water and the baptismal font, treated with the other blessings in §13.15;
- the **exorcism of the possessed**, the work of the minor order of exorcist and of the "devil banishers". This is treated with the rites for the sick in §13.8.

Only the first was in dispute among evangelicals. For the minor order of exorcist see Chapter 16 §16.3.

#### 13.4.1 Luther's exorcism and its defenders

**Luther's view.** Luther kept a shortened exorcism in 1526 and defended it as an earnest act of the church: "it is no jest to deal against the devil". In his epilogue the church "confesseth before God that the child is possessed of the devil" (*es sei vom teufel besessen*; Sehling 1, p. 21).

**Dietrich's gloss: the exorcism is a prayer.** The Lutheran defenders explained the formula as a confession of original sin and a kind of prayer, not a charm. Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda put a gloss against the "Ich beschwere dich" to say so. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 506):

> Ich beschwere dich, du unrainer geist, (R: Diser exorcismus ist nicht unrecht; denn er ist eben als ein gebeth) bei dem namen des Vaters und des Suns, und des Heiligen Geistes, das du ausfarest und weichest von disem diener (dieser dienerin) Jesu Christi, N. Amen.

I adjure thee, thou unclean spirit (margin: This exorcism is not wrong; for it is even as a prayer), in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost, that thou come out and depart from this servant (this handmaid) of Jesus Christ, N. Amen.

**Zweibrücken 1539: optional, but grounded in the fathers.** The Zweibrücken order kept it "where it can fitly be kept". It appealed to the fathers and to its use in showing "what harm original sin bringeth". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Form und Ordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 59):

> Der Exorcismus, wa er fuglich kan gehalten werden oder ist, bleybt. Den hatt fast die gantz christlich Kyrch gebraucht, wie Sanct Augustin anzeigt de Ecclesiasticis dogmatibus, cap. 21, und ist fast dienstlich zu beweisen, was schaden die erbsund bringt und wie der teuffel, ein furst der welt, allein durch Christum ußgetrieben werde.

The exorcism, where it can fitly be kept or is [kept], remaineth. Almost the whole Christian church hath used it, as Saint Augustine showeth, *De ecclesiasticis dogmatibus*, chapter 21, and it is very serviceable to show what harm original sin bringeth, and how the devil, a prince of the world, is driven out by Christ alone.

**Verden 1606: a reminder, not a cause.** The late Lutheran orders kept it under an explicit caveat. The Verden order of 1606 says the child is rescued by baptism, not by the exorcism. Sehling's editor notes that the exorcism was kept in the Lüneburg, Wolfenbüttel and Mecklenburg orders as well. **Stift Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 172):

> Allhie ist zu merken, nachdem wir in den kirchen dieses unsers stifts Verden aus erheblichen und in Gottes wort wolgegründeten ursachen den exorcismum behalten, das die prediger das volk zu zeiten erinnern sollen, das dieselbige keinesweges also verstanden werde, als solte das kind durch den exorcismum und nicht vielmehr durch die heilige taufe auß der gewalt des teufels genonnnen und errettet werden, sondern das es allein ein erinnerung sey, in was grosser not und gefehrlichen jammer das kindlein seiner sünden halben stecke, warumb ihme die heilige taufe nötig, und was durch dieselbige bey den kindlein außgerichtet werde.

Here it is to be noted: since in the churches of this our foundation of Verden we have kept the exorcism for weighty causes well grounded in God's word, the preachers shall from time to time remind the people that it be in no wise so understood as though the child were taken and rescued out of the power of the devil through the exorcism, and not rather through holy baptism; but that it is only a reminder in what great need and perilous misery the little child is sunk by reason of its sins, why holy baptism is needful for it, and what is wrought in the little children thereby.

Other late Lutheran orders took the same line:

- **Schaumburg 1614** kept it "as an outward ceremony ordained by the most ancient teachers of the church, in its free use hitherto" (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 151).

- **Soest 1609** kept it but left it free to the preachers. It cited Polycarp Leyser's *Vom Exorcismo* against the "Anhalt sacramentarians" (Sehling 22, p. 492).
- **Pomerania 1569** forbade anyone to dispute the exorcism and the crosses in public, and ruled that the child might be baptized naked or with only the head bared, "for one baptizeth not the swaddling clothes but the man". **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 386):

> De hilige döpe schal geholden werden mit den ceremonien, de im catechismo unde in der agenda beschreven sint, unde schal nemande gestadet werden, öffentlick vam exorcismo edder crützen, so im catechismo stan, to disputeren, de kinder schölen ock ane underscheed, naket, effte allene up dat hövet in den windelen gedöfft, unde nene disputation edder bekümmernisse hir van gemaket werden, wente men döpet, nicht de windelen, sunder den minschen.

Holy baptism shall be held with the ceremonies that are written in the catechism and in the agenda, and none shall be suffered to dispute openly of the exorcism or the crosses which stand in the catechism; the children shall also be baptized without distinction, naked, or only on the head in the swaddling clothes, and no disputation or trouble be made hereof, for one baptizeth not the swaddling clothes, but the man.

#### 13.4.2 No exorcism over the child already baptized

Even the orders that kept the exorcism agreed that it must not be read over a child brought to church after emergency baptism. To do so would call the Holy Spirit, who is with the baptized child, an unclean spirit. Bugenhagen gave the reason in Braunschweig in 1528. The same rule stands in Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, the Haderslev articles of 1528, Pomerania 1535, Buxtehude, the Wittenberg town order of 1533 and the Mansfeld agenda of 1580 (Sehling 7/1, p. 73; 23, p. 67; 4, p. 330; 1, p. 703; 2, p. 219). **Braunschweig, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 360):

> Overs de prester schal nicht over deme so gedofften kyndeken den exorcismum lesen, den düvel uthtobannen, dat he nicht mit deme lesen den hilgen Geist lestere, de gewislick by deme gedofften kynde is.

But the priest shall not read the exorcism over the child so baptized, to ban the devil out, lest with the reading he blaspheme the Holy Ghost, who is surely with the baptized child.

#### 13.4.3 Toleration and mitigation

**Henneberg 1582: tolerated for a time.** Some Lutheran territories held the exorcism free but removed it from the printed rite, tolerating it "for a while" where it was still used. The reason was that, bordering on the papacy, they found it "often thriving into superstition and misuse". **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst, 1582** (Sehling 2, pp. 304–305):

> Vom exorcismo. Den exorcismum oder beschwerung des bösen geistes anlangende, lassen wir wol dieselbige in rechtem gesunden verstande fur ein bekentnis, oder wie etliche wollen, fur eine art eines gebets, bei iren wirden bleiben, verweisen es auch niemand, der solche beschwerung aus christlicher freiheit, so wol als dieselbige auch aus gleicher freiheit unterlassen und abgethan werden mag, im brauch behelt. Doch haben wir unsers orts, als an das babstumb grenzend, im werk befunden, das solche bei den leuten oftmals in aberglauben und missbrauch gedeien wollen. […] als ist dieselbige in vorgeschriebener action der heiligen taufe unterlassen und dahin geschlossen worden, das solche beschwerung noch ein zeitweile, darmit der gemeine mann der gelegenheit derhalben desto besser und gründlicher in den predigten unterrichtet, und als denn soviel mehr ohne ergernus abgethan und unterlassen werden möge, tolerirt und zugebrauchen nachgelassen werden solle, jedoch an denen orten unserer fürstlichen grafschaft allein, do dieselbige noch im gebrauch.

Of the exorcism. As touching the exorcism or adjuring of the evil spirit, we let the same indeed, in a right and sound understanding, as a confession, or as some will, as a kind of prayer, remain in its worth, and blame no one who keepeth such adjuring in use out of Christian liberty, even as the same may also out of like liberty be left off and done away. Yet we in our place, as bordering on the papacy, have found in practice that it will often thrive among the people into superstition and misuse. […] therefore it is left out in the prescribed action of holy baptism, and it is concluded that such adjuring shall for a while yet be tolerated and allowed to be used, that the common man may be the better and more thoroughly instructed meanwhile in the sermons, and it may then be done away and left off so much the more without offence, yet only in those places of our princely county where it is still in use.

**Brandenburg-Ansbach 1591: "Ich gebiete dir".** The Franconian margraviate softened the words of the general visitation of 1591. "Ich beschwere dich" became "Ich gebiete dir" ("I command thee"), the crosses were dropped, and the consistory ordered the mitigated form to be used everywhere "to prevent offence and needless strife". **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594** (Sehling 11, p. 392):

> Weil auch der exorcismus in unser kirchenordnung aus erheblichen ursachen in der generalvisitation mit etlichen worten mitigirt und gelindert, auch die papistischen creuz abgeton worden, soll vortan solche mitigation von den kirchendienern an allen orten im fürstentumb under- und oberhalb des gebirgs, ärgernis und unnötig gezenk zu verhueten, gleich gehalten und derenthalben keine spaltung angefangen werden.

Since also the exorcism in our church order hath for weighty causes been mitigated and softened in some words at the general visitation, and the papistical crosses done away, such mitigation shall henceforth be kept alike by the ministers of the church in all places in the principality below and above the mountains, to prevent offence and needless strife, and no division be begun on that account.

**Ysenburg-Birstein 1588: let it fall gradually.** The Ysenburg order of 1588 directed that the exorcism, "since it hath for the most part fallen among all the orthodox", should not be brought back where it had lapsed, and should be dropped gradually elsewhere. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 628):

> Zu mercken: Weil der Exorcismus bey allen rechtgleubigen meystlich gefallen, daß man in an denen Orten, da er bißher nicht gewesen ist, nicht wider eynführen soll. Da er aber noch im brauch gehalten wirdt, soll man ihn hinfurt allgemach, so viel ohne ergernuß der gemeynen Leuth geschehen mag, fallen lassen.

To be noted: since the exorcism hath for the most part fallen among all the orthodox, it shall not be brought in again in those places where it hath not been hitherto. But where it is still kept in use, it shall henceforth be let fall by degrees, so far as may be done without offence of the common people.

#### 13.4.4 Abolition

**Strasbourg and the Upper German orders** never had the exorcism after the mid-1520s. Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 has none (§13.3.5). Sehling's editor notes that the Kassel order of 1539 (Moderate Reformed) "following Strasbourg forms" leaves it out (Sehling 8, p. 119). The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) also omits it from its two baptismal forms. It mentions "the prayers together with the exorcisms" only in the section on emergency baptism, which it copied from the Saxon agenda (Sehling 8, p. 284).

**Abolition by mandate, 1567–1613.** From the 1560s the Reformed and Philippist territories abolished it by mandate:

| Territory | Date | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Upper Palatinate (Amberg; Reformed) | 1567 | mandate of 20 January (Sehling 13, p. 303) |
| Nassau-Dillenburg (Philippist) | 1575 | agenda (Sehling 10, p. 150) |
| Hohenlohe | 1578 | order (Sehling 15, p. 235) |
| Nördlingen | 1579 | order, at Andreae's wish (Sehling 12, p. 352) |
| Moers (Reformed) | 1581 | order (Sehling 22, p. 194) |
| Waldeck | 1584 | mandate of 21 August, with the *Westerhemd* (Sehling 9, p. 300) |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) | 1588 | order (Sehling 22, p. 269) |
| Anhalt (Philippist) | 1590 | princely command of 27 July, and a new *Taufbüchlein* (Sehling 2, p. 531) |
| Electoral Saxony | 1591 | under Christian I; Sehling records the negotiations and the "unrest" (Sehling 1, p. 137) |
| Gottorf | 1613 | (Sehling 23, p. 324) |

**Nassau-Dillenburg 1575.** The Nassau agenda gives the Reformed case. Baptism by Christ's institution is strong enough against the devil. The exorcism has no ground in Scripture or apostolic tradition, and it breeds an *opinio cultus et necessitatis*. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 150):

> Zum andern soll auch der exorcismus unnd teuffelsbeschwerung bey der tauff nit meher gepraucht werden, dan wir die heylige tauff weis der einsatzungh unsers hern Jesu Cristi ohn einige menschliche tradition kreftig genug erkennen und halten, dem teuffel zu begegenen unnd ihm alle seine gewalt unnd reich zu nemen. Darzu ist der exorcismus bey der tauffe in Gottes wort und den apostolischen tradicionen nicht gegrundet, auch unnotig, unnd haben noch vill einen aberglaubischen misverstandt darbey, opinionem cultus et necessitatis, welches das werck an ihm selbß verdunckelt, unnd helt die einfaltigen von betrachtung notige dinge ab.

Secondly, the exorcism and adjuring of the devil shall no more be used at baptism, for we know and hold holy baptism, according to the institution of our Lord Jesus Christ, without any human tradition, to be strong enough to meet the devil and to take from him all his power and kingdom. Moreover the exorcism at baptism is not grounded in God's word and the apostolic traditions, and is also needless, and many have yet a superstitious misunderstanding therewith, an *opinion of worship and of necessity*, which darkeneth the work in itself and holdeth the simple back from the consideration of needful things.

**Waldeck 1584.** The Waldeck counts' mandate abolishing both the exorcism and the *Westerhemd* shows the care taken over the people's consciences. Pastors were to teach that children already baptized with them had been rightly baptized, and that future children would lack nothing. **Waldeck, mandate on the baptismal exorcism and robe, 21 August 1584** (Sehling 9, p. 300):

> daß nun hinfurtter in unsern kirchen uß darzu sonderlich bewegenden ursachen der exorcismus undt westerhempt bey der kinderlein tauff ußgelassen undt nitt mehr gebraucht werden soll [...] Undt damitt ewere gemeine darunter nitt geergertt werden undt es nit etwa davor achten möge, alß weren ihre vorige kinder ohnrecht getaufft oder die kunfftigen nitt vollenkommene taufft, wan die gedachte beiden stücke darbey ußgelassen wurden, bekommen soltten

that henceforth in our churches, for causes especially moving thereto, the exorcism and the chrisom-robe shall be left out at the baptism of little children and no more used [...] And that your congregation be not offended thereat, and do not perchance account it as though their former children were wrongly baptized, or the future ones should not receive a perfect baptism when the said two pieces were left out therewith

**Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588.** The Bentheim order states the Reformed objection in a sentence: the exorcisms "have no ground in the Word of God" and were not used at circumcision, nor in the time of Christ and the apostles. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 269):

> daß die bißanhero bey der Tauff gebrauchte aberglaubische Ceremonien und fürnemblich die Exorcismi, die keinen grundt im Wort Gottes haben und im alten Testament bey der Beschneidung und hernach in den zeiten Christi unnd der heiligen Aposteln nicht im brauch gewesen und mehr die Tauff und alle andere Ceremonien zuvertunckelen dann zuerklaren dienen, abgeschaffet werden

that the superstitious ceremonies hitherto used at baptism, and chiefly the exorcisms, which have no ground in the Word of God, and were not in use in the Old Testament at circumcision, nor thereafter in the times of Christ and the holy apostles, and serve rather to darken than to explain baptism and all other ceremonies, be done away

**Anhalt 1590: a new baptismal book** (Philippist). Sehling describes the Anhalt book. It "agreeth almost wholly with Luther's *Taufbüchlein*". The exorcism formula is left out, and the opening exhortation of Duke Henry's agenda is added (Sehling 2, p. 531). The exorcism thus became the outward sign by which a Lutheran territory was suspected of Calvinism. Sehling notes for Anhalt that the abolition, "objectively taken", involved no change of confession "with the removal of this adiaphoron", but that the estates took it otherwise (Sehling 2, p. 530).

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## 13.5 Churching of women after childbirth

The medieval church received the mother back at her first churching, about six weeks after the birth. The priest "led her in" (*einleiten*, *introductio*) and blessed her (*einsegnen*, *aussegnen*). The rite was modelled on the purification of Leviticus 12, and popular belief held that the woman in childbed was in the devil's power until it was done. The evangelical orders took three positions on it:

- **abolition**, because it implied that childbirth defiled;
- **recasting as a thanksgiving**, the *Kirchgang* of the *Sechswöchnerin*;
- **leaving it free**, as a thanksgiving the mother might make of her own accord.

#### 13.5.1 Abolished as a papal superstition

The Saxon visitors of 1540 put "leading in" the bride and the woman after childbirth among the ceremonies to be wholly abolished, with sprinkling, the blessing of salt and water, ringing for souls and ringing against storms. **Saxony (Albertine), *Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatorn*, 1540** (Sehling 1, p. 285):

> Vom einleiten und dergleichen. Forthin soll genzlich abgeschaffet sein der braut und sechswochnerin einleiten, sprengen, salz und wasser weihen, für die seelen, und das wetter leuten, und was des dinges mehr ist.

Of leading in and the like. Henceforth shall be wholly done away the leading in of the bride and of the woman after childbed, sprinkling, the hallowing of salt and water, ringing for the souls and ringing against the weather, and whatever more there is of such things.

The same words recur at Saalfeld in 1533, in the general report for the Meissen district of 1540 and in Quedlinburg (Sehling 1, pp. 654, 565; 2, p. 262). Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 joined the abolition to pastoral teaching for the women themselves. Women in childbed are not in the devil's power, and their visions and dreams come from bodily weakness. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 177):

> Es sollen auch die pfarherr und prediger die kindbetterin unterrichten, das sie nicht in gewalt des Teufels sein, wie mans bisher nicht on sundern nachtail der gewissen darfür gehalten und gröblich daran geirret hat. […] Darumb ist auch das einsegnen nach dem kindbett nicht von nöten; dann es aus lauter aberglauben fleust, gleich als weren sie durch die geburt, die aus Gottes segnen kumbt, entheiliget. Doch sollen sie nichts dester weniger ir gebürliche zeit sich innen halten, auf das sie inen selbs und den kindlein nicht schaden zufügen an iren leibs gesundheiten

The pastors and preachers shall also instruct the women in childbed that they are not in the power of the devil, as hath hitherto been held, not without especial hurt to consciences, and grossly erred therein. […] Therefore also the blessing after childbed is not needful; for it floweth from mere superstition, as though they were unhallowed by the birth, which cometh of God's blessing. Yet shall they none the less keep within doors their due time, that they do no hurt to themselves and to the little children in their bodily health

The fullest argument is in the order for Thüngen, a lordship in Franconia, of 1564. It gives six reasons against the blessing. One is that it had bred "superstition and sorcery with blessings, St John's Gospel, hallowed waters, salt, herbs, candles and the like". It insists that the six weeks' lying-in be kept for the mother's health, against "hard, tyrannical husbands" who drove their wives back to work on the third or fourth day. And it says that abolishing the blessing does not abolish thanksgiving. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 740):

> Wir wollen auch das abschaffen, das das einsegnen keinesweges dohin gemeint oder verstanden wird, als ob die kindbetterin Gott dem Allmechtigen die schuldige und gebürliche danksagung fur die leibesfrucht und fur den gnedigen beistand, schutz und erhaltung nicht erzeigen und tun solten, sondern sollen in viel wege darzu ermahnet sein, doch darneben gelehrt werden, daß solche notwendige danksagung an keinen gewissen ort, stunde oder zeit gebunden sei

We will also abolish it in such wise that the abolishing of the blessing be in no wise meant or understood as though the women in childbed should not show and render to God Almighty due and fitting thanksgiving for the fruit of the womb and for his gracious help, protection and preservation; but they shall be exhorted thereto in many ways, yet withal be taught that such needful thanksgiving is bound to no certain place, hour or time

The Lutheran Harlingerland order of 1573/74 kept the six weeks "not for the sake of the law of Moses, which we in no wise accept". It forbade husbands to force their wives out early, and "rejects the introduction or leading in of the women, as was customary in the papacy" (Sehling 7/1, p. 731).

#### 13.5.2 Kept as a thanksgiving: the *Kirchgang*

Many Lutheran territories kept the mother's first churching as a public thanksgiving at the altar.

**Querfurt.** The Magdeburg visitors in Querfurt asked "whether he leadeth in the woman after childbirth". Sehling's note records the outcome: the custom had already ceased in the town but not in the villages, and "from now on a thanksgiving shall take place from the pulpit or before the altar when the woman goeth to church" (Sehling 2, p. 460).

**Brandenburg.** The Brandenburg town recesses of 1558 (Wusterhausen among them) and the visitation and consistorial order of 1573 kept the "laudably received" offering at the altar by the woman at her churching, as by the bride at her wedding, and gave it to the pastor (Sehling 3, pp. 232, 353, 119). A Frankfurt (Oder) church book described in 1600 contained an *Einsegnung der Sechswöchnerinnen in ihrem Kirchgang*, "as in the Mark agenda of 1572" (Sehling 3, p. 215).

**Lippe.** The Lippe order kept the churching but left it free. Such a woman "may of her own free mind go to church, thank God and pray further for grace" (Sehling 21, p. 315).

**The Mansfeld *Einsegenbüchlein*, 1580.** The Mansfeld agenda prints a complete form, the *Einsegenbüchlein*. The order is:

1. An address to the women.
2. The Lord's Prayer.
3. Psalms 127 and 128.
4. A collect of thanksgiving and intercession for the child.
5. A blessing of the child with the sign of the cross.

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 222):

> III. Das einsegen büchlein. Was man aus gottes wort uber die weiber zu lesen und beten pfleget, wenn sie die kinder nach den sechswochen in die kirche bringen. Ir lieben weiber (oder da nur eine person sol eingesegnet werden, liebes weib) weil euch der liebe gott genediglich geholfen und zur geburt einen frölichen anblick gegeben, dem (oder den) kindlein die heilige taufe und uber das auch euch einen frölichen kirchgang bescheret hat, so seid ir ime dafür zu danken schuldig und zu bitten, das er euch ferner sampt dem (oder den) kindlein an leib und seele sterken, in allem guten führen und leiten und für allem argen bewaren wolle. Demnach so betet mit mir also: [Folgt das Vaterunser.] Der 127. psalm [folgt der Psalm]. Der 128. psalm [folgt der Psalm]. Lasst uns beten. O allmechtiger barmherziger gott, der du diesem weibe, in ihrer grossen angst (diesen weibern, in ihren grossen engsten) und kindes nöten gehulfen, und darzu fröliche frucht (früchte) bescheret, mit der taufe und heiligen geist begnadet hast, wir loben dich und danken dir ewiglich und bitten dich durch Jesum Christum deinen lieben son, du woltest dich uber dis (diese) kindlein erbarmen, das (die) auch behüten für allem ubel, sterken, mit deinem geist pflegen und warten, damit es (sie) in rechtem glauben erzogen, und böstendiglich dir allzeit gehorsam zu sein, dich lobe, ehre und preise, (loben, ehren und preisen), mit allen auserwehlten, hier und dort ewiglich, amen. Und du (ir) kindlein, der herr gesegne dich, auf allen deinen (euch, auf allen euren) wegen, von nu an bis in ewigkeit, † . Amen.

III. The churching book. What is wont to be read out of God's word and prayed over the women when they bring the children into church after the six weeks. Ye dear women (or where only one person is to be churched, dear woman), since the dear God hath graciously helped you and given you a joyful sight at the birth, hath granted to the child (or the children) holy baptism and to you moreover a joyful churching, ye are bound to thank him therefor and to pray that he will further strengthen you together with the child (or the children) in body and soul, guide and lead you in all good and keep you from all evil. Therefore pray with me thus: [The Our Father follows.] The 127th psalm [the psalm follows]. The 128th psalm [the psalm follows]. Let us pray. O almighty, merciful God, who hast helped this woman in her great anguish (these women in their great anguish) and travail, and hast moreover granted joyful fruit (fruits), and endued it with baptism and the Holy Ghost: we praise thee and thank thee for ever, and pray thee through Jesus Christ thy dear Son that thou wouldest have mercy upon this (these) little child(ren), keep it also from all evil, strengthen it, tend and care for it with thy Spirit, that it may be brought up in right faith and constantly, being obedient to thee always, may praise, honour and glorify thee with all the elect, here and there for ever. Amen. And thou (ye) little child(ren), the Lord bless thee on all thy (you on all your) ways, from this time forth for evermore, †. Amen.

The same agenda adds pastoral rubrics for the hard cases:

- **If the mother dies before her churching**, the midwife brings the child, and a prayer of thanks for the child's birth and baptism is said over it.
- **If the child dies within the six weeks**, the woman is not led to the altar, "for that one should bid her step before the priest to the Lord's altar without her little child might grieve her yet more". She is to go to church quietly with the other Christians.

- **If a woman refuses the churching "out of mere defiance"**, despising the prayers over herself and her child, the pastor is to admonish her. If she will not hear, he is to report her to the superintendent and consistory.

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 223):

> Wenn sich solche felle zutragen, das den müttern ire kindlein mit tode abgehen, ehe die zeit irer sechs wochen umb ist, so lesset mans mit dem kirchgange bleiben, das solche weiber nicht dürfen zum altar geleitet, und für den priester gestelt werden, sondern das dieselben (wenn sie zu irer gesundheit komen sind, und die zeit ires kirchganges verhanden ist) stillschweigend mit andern christen zur kirchen gehen und ir betrübnis, darinnen sie von wegen des tödlichen abgangs irer kinderlein sein, in warer demut unserem lieben herrn gotte fürtragen, im glauben umb gedult und trost und umb fernern segen nach gottes willen bitten. Denn das man sie ohne kinderlein solte heissen für den priester zum altar des herrn treten, möchte sie vielleicht noch mehr und höher betrüben.

When such cases befall that the mothers' little children depart by death before the time of their six weeks is out, the churching is let be, so that such women need not be led to the altar and set before the priest; but they shall (when they are come to their health and the time of their churching is at hand) go silently to church with other Christians, and lay their sorrow, wherein they are by reason of the death of their little children, before our dear Lord God in true humility, and pray in faith for patience and comfort and for further blessing according to God's will. For that one should bid them step before the priest to the altar of the Lord without their little children might perhaps grieve them yet more and more deeply.

**Sayn 1590.** Sayn printed a long prayer "which the ministers of the church shall use when the women after six weeks go out of childbed to church". It thanks God that he "hath been a faithful helper in need and stood by her in her deadly anguish" (Sehling 19/1, p. 401).

**Solms 1599** (Reformed). Solms forbade the woman in childbed to go out before four weeks. She was then to present herself to the pastor, and the christening feast was to be put off until her churching (Sehling 9, p. 340).

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## 13.6 Confirmation

**No chrismation.** No evangelical order in the corpus anoints at confirmation, and none keeps confirmation as a sacrament. The papal *Firmung* is rejected everywhere: its claim that no one is a full Christian until anointed by the bishop, and its formula "Signo te signo crucis et confirmo te chrismate salutis". The one order that kept the chrism at all, Electoral Brandenburg in 1540, kept it at baptism (§13.3.2), not at confirmation.

**What replaced it.** Most orders kept or created an evangelical confirmation with three parts:

1. **Instruction** in the catechism.
2. **A public examination and confession of faith** before the congregation, usually at a feast, by children of about ten to fourteen who were to be admitted to the Lord's Supper.
3. **Prayer, usually with the laying on of hands.**

The Saxon orders, by contrast, often treated the examination itself as "the right Christian confirmation" and had no separate rite.

### 13.6.1 The reformers' proposal

The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545, signed by Luther, Melanchthon and the other Wittenberg theologians, proposed confirmation as "a profitable ceremony". It was "not for show", but for the keeping of right doctrine and good discipline.
**Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 211):

> Confirmation. Dieses wäre hochnöthig in allen kirchen, den catechismum auf bestimpte tage zu halten, die jugend in allen nöthigen artikeln christlicher lehre zu unterweisen. Dazu möcht die confirmation angericht werden, nämlich, so ein kind zu seinen mündigen jaren kommen, öffentlich sein bekenntniss zu hören, und zu fragen, ob es bei dieser einigen göttlicher lehre und kirchen bleiben wollt, und nach der bekenntniss und zusage mit auflegung der hände ein gebet thuen. Dieses wäre ein nützliche ceremonien, nicht allein zum schein, sondern viel mehr zu erhaltung rechter lahr und reines verstands und zu guter zucht dienlich.

Confirmation. This were most needful in all churches: to hold the catechism on set days, to instruct the youth in all needful articles of Christian doctrine. Thereto might confirmation be set up, namely, when a child is come to its years of discretion, to hear its confession publicly, and to ask whether it would abide by this one divine doctrine and church, and after the confession and promise to make a prayer with laying on of hands. This were a profitable ceremony, not only for show, but much rather serviceable to the keeping of right doctrine and pure understanding, and to good discipline.

### 13.6.2 Hesse 1539: the Ziegenhain and Kassel forms

**Ziegenhain 1539** (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian confirmation, devised with Bucer in the Ziegenhain order on discipline and the Kassel church order of 1539, is the source of most later forms. Sehling's editor traces its spread to Calenberg-Göttingen 1542, Waldeck 1556/57, Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1569 and Hoya 1581, among others (Sehling 8, p. 104, n. 17). The Ziegenhain rule sets out the whole act:

- the children are presented by their parents and godparents at a chief feast;
- the elders and ministers stand round;
- the pastor examines them in the chief articles of faith;
- they give themselves publicly to Christ and his church;
- the congregation prays;
- the pastor lays on hands and admits them to the Lord's table.

**Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 104):

> Es sollen auch die eltesten und prediger versehen, daß die kinder, so nun durch die catechismos im christlichen verstande so weit bracht sein, daß man sie billich solle zum tisch des Herren zulassen, uf ein fürnemes fest, als Ostern, Pfingsten und Weihnachten, für aller gemein dem pfarherr an darzu verordnetem ort von ihren eltern und pettern dargestellet werden, umb den die eltesten und alle ander diener des worts stehen sollen. Da solle der pfarherr dieselbigen kinder die fürnemsten stücke des christlichen glaubens befragen, und nachdem die kinder darauf geantwort, sich auch da offentlich Christo dem Herren und seiner kirchen ergeben haben, soll der pfarherr die gemein vermanen, den Herrn diesen kindern umb bestendigkeit und merung des h. Geistes zu bitten und solches gebet mit einer collect beschließen. Dem allem nach soll dann der pfarherr denselbigen kindern die hende auflegen und sie also im namen des Herrn confirmieren und zu christlicher gemeinschaft bestetigen, auch darauf zum tisch des Herren gehen heißen

The elders and preachers shall also provide that the children who are now brought so far in Christian understanding through the catechisms that they may rightly be admitted to the table of the Lord be presented on a chief feast, as Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, before all the congregation, to the pastor at a place appointed thereto, by their parents and godparents, round about whom the elders and all other ministers of the word shall stand. There shall the pastor question the same children in the chief parts of the Christian faith; and after the children have answered thereto, and have also there publicly given themselves to Christ the Lord and his church, the pastor shall exhort the congregation to pray the Lord for these children for steadfastness and increase of the Holy Ghost, and conclude such prayer with a collect. After all this the pastor shall then lay hands on the same children, and so confirm them in the name of the Lord and establish them in Christian fellowship, and thereupon bid them go to the table of the Lord

### 13.6.3 A full form: Calenberg-Göttingen 1542

The Calenberg order of Duchess Elisabeth printed a separate *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*. It took its prayers and formula from the Erfurt edition of the Kassel order. Its rite is:

1. **Times.** Three times a year, at Easter, Pentecost and Christmas, after vespers.
2. **Ministers.** Two or three neighbouring pastors and, if near, the superintendent, "with due reverence".
3. **An exhortation** against the papal *Firmung* and its oil. The ceremony has two parts: *catechesis* and *impositio manuum*.
4. **The hymn** *Kom, heiliger Geist*.
5. **The examination** through the whole catechism, "kindly and gently, that they be not frightened".
6. **A bidding and two long prayers**, the first ending in a paraphrase of the Lord's Prayer.
7. **The laying on of hands** on each child, with the formula below.
8. ***Te Deum*** or a psalm of thanks.

The rubric even asks for a place in the middle of the church where all can see and hear. The exhortation gives the order's view of the old rite. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, pp. 838–839):

> Denn ists nicht ein nerrische lahr, darin sie furgeben, es konne keiner ein Christ sein, wenn er gleich die tauf empfangen, er seye dan auch gesalbet und gefirmet durch den bisschoff? Ja, wie wöllen sie beweisen, das solcher oley der firmung ein oley des heils sey? […] Aber wir wollen diese affen mit ihrer falschen lahr und unnützen salbungen faren lassen, der heiligen taufe ihre wirde nicht rauben und auch keinem leiblichen oley das heil, sonder allein dem Herrn Christo zuschreiben. Doch weil diese ceremonia des confirmirens, wenn sie recht gebraucht wird, dennoch wol zu leiden und zu erhaltung der kinderzucht sehre nütze ist, so wöllen wir mit Gotts hülfe unterstehen, den rechten brauch derselbigen widerumb in unser kirchen zu bringen

For is it not a foolish doctrine wherein they pretend that none can be a Christian, though he have received baptism, unless he be also anointed and confirmed by the bishop? Yea, how will they prove that such oil of confirmation is an oil of salvation? […] But we will let these apes go with their false doctrine and needless anointings, not rob holy baptism of its worth, and ascribe salvation to no bodily oil, but to the Lord Christ alone. Yet since this ceremony of confirming, when it is rightly used, is nevertheless well to be suffered and very profitable to the keeping of discipline among children, we will undertake with God's help to bring the right use of it again into our church

The words at the laying on of hands, taken from Kassel, became the most widely used evangelical confirmation formula. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 843):

> Wenn solch gebet geschehen, sol der pfarherr einem jeden kinde insonderheit die hand auflegen und also sagen: Nim hin den heiligen Geist, schutz und schirm fur allem argen, sterke und hülfe zu allem guten, von der gnedigen hand Gottes des Vaters, des Sohns und des heiligen Geists. Amen. Darauf singe dan die gemein einen dankpsalm oder das Te Deum laudamus.

When such prayer is done, the pastor shall lay his hand upon each child severally and say thus: Receive the Holy Ghost, protection and defence against all evil, strength and help unto all good, from the gracious hand of God the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen. Thereupon let the congregation sing a psalm of thanks or the *Te Deum laudamus*.

The order is careful to deny that the Spirit is given "for the sake of the outward ceremony of laying on". He is given "for the sake of the word and prayer of the church", for "Augustine calleth such laying on of hands nothing else than prayer" (Sehling 6/2, p. 841).

#### 13.6.4 Brandenburg 1540: confirmation by the bishop

Electoral Brandenburg, which kept its bishops, restored confirmation "according to the old custom". The bishop examines the children at his visitation and confirms with the laying on of hands. Because the bishops were few, pastors might confirm in the presence of one of the bishop's learned men, at Easter and Pentecost. The order describes the ancient use as including a cross on the forehead "that they should not be ashamed of the cross of Christ", but prescribes only the laying on of hands and prayer. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 59):

> Wollen wir, das die confirmation nach dem alten brauch gehalten werde, nemlich also: wenn die getauften zu iren jaren komen, das sie wissen, was sie gleuben und beten, auch nach inhalt des catechismi wissen, wie sie christlich leben und ein erlichen wandel füren sollen, sollen sie in der visitation des bischofs erfordert und verhöret werden, und wo befunden, das sie des glaubens und christlichen wandels guten bericht haben, sol, als obstet, der bischof mit auflegung der hende, gott den allmechtigen bitten, das sie darin bestendig bleiben, erhalten und noch mehr gesterkt werden, und sie also darauf confirmiren und bestetigen.

We will that confirmation be held according to the old custom, namely thus: when the baptized come to their years, so that they know what they believe and pray, and also know according to the content of the catechism how they ought to live as Christians and lead an honest conversation, they shall be summoned and heard at the bishop's visitation; and where it is found that they have good knowledge of the faith and of Christian conversation, the bishop shall, as is said above, with laying on of hands pray God Almighty that they may remain steadfast therein, be preserved and be strengthened yet more, and so thereupon confirm and establish them.

#### 13.6.5 Mansfeld 1580 and Pomerania 1569: confirmation before first communion

**Mansfeld 1580.** The Mansfeld agenda ties confirmation to the first communion. The children recite the catechism with Luther's explanation and are examined publicly, and this is announced to the congregation. One of two prayers is said, then hands are laid on with a formula that names the absolution and the sacrament the child now desires. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 234):

> (Nach dieser gebete einem, leget man den kindern die hand auf, und betet ferner also. Dieweil du (ihr) den catechismum gelernet und für dieser christlichen gemeine offentlich bekentnis deines (eures) glaubens gethan hast (habt), und zugesagt, dabei bestendig zuverharren, und begerest (begeret) hierauf die absolution und das hochwirdige sacrament zu entpfahen, so verleihe dir (euch) gott darzu den heiligen geist, der dich (euch) regiere, schütze, und zum ewigen leben im rechten glauben, und göttlichem gehorsam erhalte, durch Christum seinen son, amen. Der segen gottes des vaters, und des sons, und des heiligen geists, komme auf dich (euch), und bleibe uber dir (euch) ewiglich, amen.

(After one of these prayers the hand is laid on the children, and [the minister] prayeth further thus:) Forasmuch as thou hast (ye have) learned the catechism and made public confession of thy (your) faith before this Christian congregation, and promised to continue steadfastly therein, and desirest (desire) thereupon to receive the absolution and the most worthy sacrament, God grant thee (you) thereto the Holy Ghost, who may rule thee (you), protect thee, and keep thee unto eternal life in right faith and godly obedience, through Christ his Son. Amen. The blessing of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost come upon thee (you), and abide upon thee (you) for ever. Amen.

**Pomerania 1569.** The Pomeranian order required confirmation once a year in every parish, or twice in the towns, in Lent and at Michaelmas, after the quarterly catechism examination. It called it "confirmation and benediction" as described in the agenda, which "hath been in use for many years in these Pomeranian churches" (Sehling 4, pp. 385–386). The agenda chapter is headed *Van der confirmation, wo men de kinder im catechismo vorhören unde insegenen schal, eer men se tom hochwerdigen sacramente tolet* ("Of confirmation, how one shall hear the children in the catechism and bless them before they are admitted to the most worthy sacrament"; Sehling 4, p. 441). **Lauenburg** in 1585 and **Hesse** in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and 1574 (Philippist) likewise printed confirmation forms with question and answer, and the Hessian form was copied by Nassau-Weilburg (1576), Corvey (1603) and Hanau-Münzenberg (1609, Reformed) (Sehling 5, p. 458; 8, pp. 300, 430; 10, pp. 251, 498; 21, p. 255).

### 13.6.6 Strasbourg and the south-west

Strasbourg came to confirmation late, against the Anabaptist charge that infant baptism had destroyed church discipline. Marbach's draft order of 1553 has a chapter *Von der kinder firmung* and a *Forma* "as it is held with the children in the parish of St Nicholas". The city clergy approved both in 1557 (Sehling 20/1, pp. 395, 446). Marbach had announced to Bucer in 1551 "a public example of confirmation and imposition of hands, a pious and Christian ceremony, with about twenty boys" after Easter (Sehling 20/1, p. 79, n. 433).

### 13.6.7 Examination without a rite: Electoral Saxony

The great Saxon order of 1580 did not adopt the laying on of hands. It instructed the pastors to teach the people that the public catechism examination of children and servants is itself "the right Christian confirmation or *Firmung*". This confirmation is the confirming of the faith that the godparents confessed at baptism. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 425):

> Und sollen die pfarrer und kirchendiener das volk fleissig unterweisen, und. mit gutem grund berichten, das dis sei die rechte christliche confirmation oder firmung, das ist die bestetigung des glaubens, so die paten an stadt des neugetauften kindleins bekant, darauf auch das kind getauft worden, wann sie nemlich solches in diesem examine erinnert, und demselben in ihrem ganzen leben nachzukommen, fleissig ermanet werden. Welches die papisten anstelien lassen und an stadt dieser christlichen firmung ein schauspiel mit den kindern angestellet

And the pastors and ministers of the church shall diligently instruct the people and inform them on good ground that this is the right Christian confirmation or *Firmung*, that is, the confirming of the faith which the godparents confessed in the stead of the newly baptized child, whereon also the child was baptized: namely when they are reminded of it in this examination, and diligently exhorted to follow it all their life long. Which the papists have let alone, and in the stead of this Christian confirmation have set up a show with the children

Waldeck in 1556 used nearly the same words of the papal *Firmung*, "a show full of superstition and error". It nonetheless printed a chapter on "how young boys and girls shall be received into the Christian congregation" (Sehling 9, pp. 283–284). The Reuss

lordships ordered that "instead of confirmation" the young be drilled in the catechism through Lent. Those found fit received the sacrament on Maundy Thursday "and are thereafter to be held confirmed Christians" (Sehling 2, p. 156).

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## 13.7 Betrothal, marriage and divorce

**Marriage as a "worldly business".** For the evangelical orders marriage is not a sacrament but "a worldly business" (*ein weltlich geschäft*), governed by civil law and local custom and judged by the marriage courts. The church's part is to proclaim the banns, to join the couple if asked, and to read God's Word over them, pray and bless. The marriage law itself (the forbidden degrees, parental consent, the marriage courts) lies outside this chapter, except where it gave the pastor a part to play: at the betrothal, at its dissolution, and at divorce and remarriage (§§13.7.8–13.7.10).

What follows is the liturgy:

- the banns;
- the joining (*Trauung*, *Zusammensprechen*), usually at the church door or before the altar;
- the blessing with readings and prayer at the altar (*Einsegnung*, *Einleitung*);
- the wedding service that replaced the nuptial Mass (*Brautmesse*);
- the rules on times, on brides who had fallen, and on widows.

Two formulas divided the country. Luther's North German "Ich spreche sie ehelich zusammen" ("I pronounce them joined in marriage") stood against the South German "Die eheliche Pflicht … bestätige ich" ("The marriage bond … I confirm"). Sehling's Franconian editor traces both to halves of one medieval formula (Sehling 11, p. 202, n. 21).

### 13.7.1 Luther's *Traubüchlein*

Luther's *Traubüchlein für die einfeltigen pfarherrn* is dated variously to 1529 and 1534 (Sehling 1, p. 23). It was printed with the Small Catechism and became the Lutheran standard. Its preface gives the principle. Marriage "is a worldly business", and "every town and land" is to keep its own customs, such as two processions to church or one and the number of banns. "But when it is desired of us to bless them before the church or in the church, to pray over them, or also to marry them, we are bound to do the same." The form follows. **Luther, *Traubüchlein*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 24):

> Zum ersten, auf der Kanzel aufbieten mit solchen Worten: Hanns N. und Greta N. wollen nach göttlicher ordenung zum heiligen stande der ehe greifen; begehren dess ein gemein geistlich gebet für sie, dass sie es in gottes namen anfahen, und wohl gerathe. Und hätte jemand was darein zu sprechen, der thue es beizeit, oder schweige darnach; gott gebe ihnen seinen segen, Amen. Für der kirchen trauen mit solchen worten: Hanns, willt du Greten zum ehelichen gemahl haben ? Dicat: Ja. Greta, willt du Hannsen zum ehelichen gemahl haben? Dicat: Ja. Hie lasse sie die trauringe einander geben, und füge ihre beide rechten hand zusammen, und spreche: Was gott zusammen füget, soll kein Mensch scheiden. Weil denn Hanns N. und Greta N. einander zur ehe begehren, und solchs hie öffentlich fur gott und der welt bekennen, darauf sie die hände und trauringe einander gegeben haben, so sprech ich sie ehelich zusammen, im namen des vaters, und des sohns, und des heiligen geistes, Amen.

First, to publish the banns from the pulpit with such words: Hans N. and Greta N. will according to God's ordinance take hold of the holy estate of matrimony; they desire for themselves the common prayer of the church, that they may begin it in God's name and that it may prosper well. And if any have aught to speak against it, let him do it betimes, or hold his peace thereafter. God give them his blessing. Amen. Before the church to marry them with such words: Hans, wilt thou have Greta to thy wedded spouse? Let him say: Yes. Greta, wilt thou have Hans to thy wedded spouse? Let her say: Yes. Here let him have them give the wedding rings to each other, and join their two right hands together, and say: What God hath joined together, let no man put asunder. Forasmuch then as Hans N. and Greta N. desire each other in marriage, and acknowledge the same here openly before God and the world, whereupon they have given each other their hands and wedding rings, I pronounce them joined in marriage, in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

At the altar the minister reads four lessons:

1. **The institution of marriage**, Genesis 2:18, 21–24.
2. **God's commandment for the estate**, Ephesians 5:22–29.
3. **The cross laid on it**, Genesis 3:16–19.

4. **Its comfort**, Genesis 1:27–28, 31 and Proverbs 18:22.

Then he stretches his hands over the couple and prays. **Luther, *Traubüchlein*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 24):

> Hie recke er die hände uber sie und bete also: Herr gott, der du mann und weib geschaffen, und zum ehestand verordnet hast, dazu mit früchte des leibes gesegnet, und das sacrament deines lieben sohns, Jesu Christi, und der kirchen, seine braut darin bezeichnet; wir bitten deine grundlose güte, du wollest solch dein geschäft, ordenung und segen nicht lassen verrücken noch verderben, sondern gnädiglich in uns bewahren, durch Jesum Christum, deinen sohn, unsern herrn, Amen.

Here let him stretch out his hands over them and pray thus: Lord God, who hast created man and woman and ordained them to the married estate, hast blessed them moreover with fruit of the body, and hast therein signified the sacrament of thy dear Son Jesus Christ and of the church his bride: we pray thy bottomless goodness that thou wilt not let this thy work, ordinance and blessing be displaced or marred, but graciously preserve it in us, through Jesus Christ thy Son our Lord. Amen.

Luther's form passed into the Saxon agenda of 1539 ("as in the *Traubüchlein*", Sehling 1, p. 274) and most North German orders. Mansfeld in 1580 prefaced it with a warning against deserters and bigamists and an address to the congregation, and added a second exhortation to the couple (Sehling 2, pp. 223–225).

### 13.7.2 The South German form: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533

The Franconian order adapted Luther "freely" (Sehling's note). Its rite is:

1. **Notice.** The couple are to give the pastor notice "a good time before", so that impediments can be searched out.
2. **The banns.** They are to be proclaimed once in towns and three times in villages, on feast days.
3. **At the church.** The questions; four readings with headings, "Zum ersten … Zum andern …" (Genesis 2, Matthew 19, Ephesians 5, Genesis 3, Genesis 1 and Proverbs 18); the rings ("if they have rings"); the joining of hands; vows spoken after the minister.
4. **The confirmation of the vows.**
5. **Luther's prayer**, then Psalm 128 and the peace.

Several couples may be married together, and the names entered in a register with the baptisms. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, pp. 201–202):

> Darnach sprech er: Wölt ir nun soliche pflicht und treu einander laisten, so gebt einander die ring darauf (haben sie anderst ring) und gebt einander die hende! Darnach sprech er dem man vor und laß ine nach sprechen also: Ich N. nime dich N. mir zu einem eelichen gemahle und gelobe dir mein treu. Desgleichen soll er dem weib auch vorsagen und darauf weiter sprechen: Die eeliche pflicht, die ir da vor Gott und seiner gemain einander gelobt habt, bestetige ich ans befelch der christenlichen gemain im namen des Vaters und des Suns und des Heiligen Gaists. Amen. Was Gott zusammenfügt, soll kein mensch schaiden.

Then let him say: If ye will now perform such duty and troth one to another, give one another the rings thereupon (if they have rings) and give one another your hands! Then let him say it before the man and let him say after him thus: I N. take thee N. to my wedded spouse and plight thee my troth. Likewise shall he say it before the woman also, and thereupon say further: The marriage duty which ye have here vowed one to another before God and his congregation I confirm by command of the Christian congregation, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. What God joineth together, let no man put asunder.

Württemberg in 1536 and 1553 used the same form, done before "the most convenient altar" after two banns (Sehling 16, p. 114).

### 13.7.3 Strasbourg 1537: the impediments asked thrice

The Strasbourg agenda puts the church's inquiry into the rite itself:

1. The minister asks the couple whether they will live in marriage and confirm their purpose before the congregation.
2. He calls three times for anyone who knows an impediment.
3. He takes their right hands and asks each for consent.

4. He "strengthens" the vows "by command of the Christian congregation".
5. A lesson (Genesis 2, Matthew 19 or Ephesians 5) and an exhortation under four heads.
6. Psalm 128, silent prayer, a long prayer that paraphrases the Lord's Prayer, and a dismissal with a charge to remember the poor.

**Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, pp. 263–264):

> Ist jemans hie, dem zu wissen sei hindernüs der Ehe ann disen personen sip oder magtschafft halben, aus götlichem gebott, uns durch unser ordenliche Oberkeit erkennet, oder das ir eins gegen anderen personen sunst verpflicht und der Ehe halb verbunden were, oder das sie ir Ehe nitt redlich unnd nach rechter ordnung versprochen hetten, der wölle das melden: Zum ersten, Zum andern, Zum dritten mal. Wo dann nichts anzeigt würt, spricht der Diener ferner: Dieweil dann niemans ist, der solichs widersprechen wille, so bestetige Gott, das er an euch gewircket hat. […] Die Eheliche pflicht, die ir da vor Gott und seiner Gemeind einander gelobt haben, besterke ich aus befelch der christlichen Gemeind, im namen des Vaters, Süns unnd Heilgen Geists, Amen.

Is there any here who knoweth of an impediment to the marriage of these persons by reason of kinship or affinity by God's commandment, as made known to us by our ordinary magistrates; or that either of them were otherwise pledged and bound in marriage to another person; or that they had not promised their marriage honestly and in right order: let him make it known. The first, the second, the third time. Where then nothing is shown, the minister saith further: Forasmuch then as there is none that will gainsay it, God confirm that which he hath wrought in you. […] The marriage duty which ye have here vowed one to another before God and his congregation I strengthen by command of the Christian congregation, in the name of the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost. Amen.

The prayer has a clause that is left out "when couples are blessed who by God's common order have no children to hope for" (Sehling 20/1, p. 266).

#### 13.7.4 The nuptial Mass replaced

**Herford 1532.** The medieval wedding Mass was abolished. In its place came the Word, the blessing and, in many places, a wedding sermon and hymns. Herford describes the change: the bridal Mass that used to be sung "before the soup" on the Monday is gone. Instead God's Word is preached and the blessing given, and the couple's offering goes to the poor chest rather than on the altar. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, p. 192):

> Desgeliken ock, wen de brudegam und bruddes mandages tho kerken gan, is ein wise gewest, vor de soppen ene brutmisse tho singen mit groter lasteringe godes und lichtverdicheit der lüde. So dat nu dorch Godes gnaden aff is und in stede der misse dat wort Godes geprediket wert, der brüdt und brüdegam de segen gegeven, is vorordent van unser gemeine, dat de brudt und brudegam mit orer fruntschop in stede des offers up dat altar, nu vortan in der armen kisten solck ein offer geven

Likewise also, when the bridegroom and the bride go to church on the Monday, it hath been a custom to sing a bridal Mass before the soup, with great blasphemy of God and frivolity of the people. Since this is now by God's grace done away, and in place of the Mass God's word is preached and the blessing given to the bride and bridegroom, it is ordained by our congregation that the bride and bridegroom with their kin shall henceforth give such an offering into the poor chest instead of the offering upon the altar

**The *Brautmesse* in the Ansbach order.** The name *Brautmesse* survived for the wedding service with its music, as the fees paid to schoolmasters for singing it show (Brandenburg, Sehling 3, pp. 124, 165, 186). The Ansbach *Ordo ecclesiasticus* of 1592 describes one held at a weekday service:

- a wedding sermon in place of the second lesson;
- before it, *Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht* or a motet;
- after the joining, *Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein gunst* or *Dein ehe soltu bewahren rein*, the commandment stanza of Luther's metrical Decalogue;
- figural music.

**Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 456):

> Wann aber ein brautmeß, dabei dann der cantor sein mus, wird dieser actus bis umb neun hor aufgezogen, da man allererst zusamschlegt, und stat der andern lection (vor welcher man die tauf verrichtet, so ein kind vorhanden zu taufen) wird eine hochzeitpredigt gelesen, auch zu zeiten vom predigstul getun. Darvor pflegt man zu singen: Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht, oder ein mutetam in cantu figurali. Nach der copulation: Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein gunst, oder Dein ehe soltu bewahren rein, sambt dem letzten gesetz des decalogi rhythmici d. Lutheri oder auch ein muteten in figuralgesang

But when there is a bridal Mass, at which the cantor must be present, this office is put off until about nine o'clock, when the bell is first struck together; and in place of the second lesson (before which baptism is done, if there be a child to baptize) a wedding sermon is read, and also at times delivered from the pulpit. Before it they are wont to sing *Wol dem, der in Gottes furchten steht*, or a motet in figural song. After the joining: *Wo Gott zum haus nicht gibt sein gunst*, or *Dein ehe soltu bewahren rein*, together with the last commandment of the rhymed Decalogue of Dr Luther, or also a motet in figural song

Mansfeld in 1580 lists the hymns "for the bridal Masses": the *Te Deum* in German, *Am dritten tage eine hochzeit ward* (on John 2) and Psalm 127, *Vergebens ist alle mühe* (Sehling 2, p. 236).

### 13.7.5 Days, hours and banns

The banns were proclaimed one to three times, on Sundays or feast days. The orders varied:

| Order | Banns | Source |
|---|---|---|
| Württemberg 1536 | twice, in the towns and market towns | (Sehling 16, p. 114) |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 | once in towns, three times in villages | (Sehling 11, p. 200) |
| Ysenburg 1587 | on three Sundays, the couple applying fourteen days before | (Sehling 10, p. 587) |

**Hours and days.** Konstanz in 1537 (Moderate Reformed) required the banns three or four days before, on a Sunday or feast. It forbade weddings "before daybreak" and the marriage of strangers without inquiry (Sehling 17, p. 415). In much of Lower Saxony the couple went to church on the Monday (Herford, above).

**Closed seasons.** Weddings were forbidden at the high feasts, in Advent and in Lent. These rules are collected in Chapter 12 §§12.11.3 and 12.12.6.

### 13.7.6 The bride who had fallen: no wreath

**Württemberg 1553.** The wreath (*Kranz*, *Kränzlein*) worn by the bride on her way to church (*Kirchgang*) was the sign of maidenhood. The marriage orders forbade it to a bride who had lain with her bridegroom before the marriage was allowed, and with it music, guests and a public wedding feast. **Württemberg, *Eheordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 279):

> So sollen sie doch beide von wegen des heimlichen beischlaffens vor zulassung der Ee unnd auch dem Kirchgang gestrafft werden, nämlich die Mannsperson acht tag in Turn an boden mit Wasser und Brot, und die Fraw vier tag in ein Frawengefencknuß gelegt werden, und darzu inen beiden Spil oder Gest auff der Hochzeit zuhaben oder ir ein Crentzlin zum Kirchgang zutragen verbotten sein.

Yet shall they both be punished by reason of the secret lying together before the marriage was allowed and before the going to church; namely, the man shall be laid eight days in the tower on the ground with water and bread, and the woman four days in a women's prison; and moreover music or guests at the wedding shall be forbidden to them both, or that she wear a wreath at the going to church.

**Ulm, Baden and Strasbourg.** The same rule stands in the Baden marriage order of 1581 and the Ulm *Zuchtordnung* of 1558. Ulm complained of brides "great with child" who went to church "with the procession and other maidenly adornment" as if they were "honourable, unblemished virgins" (Sehling 16, p. 546; 17, pp. 229, 233). Strasbourg in 1544 (Moderate Reformed) complained of the opposite fault: some would not let maidens be named at the *Kirchgang* at all (Sehling 20/1, p. 342).

### 13.7.7 Widows and widowers

Remarriage was free, but not too soon. Ysenburg-Ronneburg in 1587 and Brandenburg-Ansbach in 1573 forbade widows and widowers to marry within a quarter of a year of their spouse's death (Sehling 10, p. 587; 11, p. 369). Others limited the feast. The lordship of Homburg's wedding and baptism order of 1570 required widowers and widows to go to church without music or bridesmaids and to hold no "gift wedding" (*giftbrutlofft*, the wedding at which gifts were received), only a meal of three dishes at most (Sehling 22, p. 137). Divorced persons might remarry only with the leave of the consistory or marriage judges (Nördlingen 1579; Kurpfalz 1563, Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 346; 14, p. 285).

### 13.7.8 Betrothal

**The betrothal made the marriage.** In sixteenth-century law the betrothal (*Verlöbnis*, *Ehegelübde*, *Eheversprechen*, *sponsalia*), sealed by the handshake (*Handschlag*, *Handstreich*), the ring or the *Weinkauf* drink, bound the couple, and the church wedding (*Kirchgang*) confirmed it. Hohenlohe's editor notes that the hand-joining and ring of the church rite came from the betrothal, and that in Hohenlohe the betrothal was still held to found the marriage (Sehling 15, pp. 79, 291). The evangelical orders made the betrothal public and brought the pastor into it in three ways:

- **Secret betrothals void.** Betrothals made "in corners", without the knowledge of parents or guardians, were declared null: Saxony 1540 (*winkelehegelübde*), Henneberg 1545, Erbach 1572 and many others (Sehling 1, p. 285; 2, p. 283; 9, p. 450). Luther had advised that "secret betrothals be abolished and count for nothing" (quoted by Sehling 7/2.1, p. 895, editor's note).
- **The pastor's examination.** Before the banns the pastor was to question the betrothed: are they free, are they related within the forbidden degrees, have they their parents' consent? Brandenburg-Ansbach 1556 and Wolfstein 1574 give the questions (Sehling 11, p. 335; 13, p. 584). Nassau-Weilburg in 1576 required those who meant to marry to report to the officers and pastor "before the promise is made and confirmed with the yea" (Sehling 10, p. 268).
- **Betrothal before the pastor.** Wertheim went furthest. Its order of 1530 required every marriage to be "contracted before the pastor, in the presence of the *Schultheiß* and two jurors", and gave the pastor seven questions. The handshake itself was to wait until the banns had been read three times and the couple came "before the church or altar on the wedding day".

**Wertheim, *Kirchenordnung*, about 1555, incorporating the instruction of 1530** (Sehling 11, p. 717):

> Darumb gefält uns, daß ein jegliche ehe betaidinget werde vor dem pfarrer, in beisein des schultheißen und zweier schöpfen. Doch soll der handschlag nicht geschehen, bis die eheleute dreimal verkündiget und ausgeschrien werden. [...] Erstlichs soll er die personen, so einander zu der ehe begeren, fragen, ob sie auch mit gunst ihrer eltern und vormund heiraten und ob sie beweisen können, daß sie von denselben gunst und willen erlangt haben. Zum andern soll er sie fragen, ob sie vorhin die ehe einander verheißen - zwischen ihnen beeden allein oder vor andern, welche doch nit von der herrschaft dazu verordnet sein. [...] Ztm dritten soll er fragen, ob kein verhinderung solcher ehe, deren von Gott verboten grad oder sippschaft vorhanden sei.

Therefore it pleaseth us that every marriage be contracted before the pastor, in the presence of the *Schultheiß* and two jurors. Yet shall the handshake not take place until the couple have been proclaimed and cried three times. [...] First he shall ask the persons that desire one another in marriage whether they marry with the favour of their parents and guardians, and whether they can prove that they have obtained favour and consent from them. Secondly he shall ask them whether they have before promised marriage to one another, between them two alone or before others who were not appointed thereto by the lordship. [...] Thirdly he shall ask whether there be no hindrance to such marriage, of the degrees or kinship forbidden by God.

The remaining questions ask whether either belongs to a foreign lordship. The couple are then told to settle the dowry now, and to promise nothing "by word or sign" until the wedding day, when the pastor will enter them for the three banns.

### 13.7.9 Breaking a betrothal

**No private dissolution.** Because a public betrothal bound, it could not be broken by the parties, their friends or the pastor. Only the consistory or marriage court could release a betrothed person. Prussia in 1575 put it plainly. **Prussia, *Visitationsabschied für Zinten*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 153):

> Wenn aber personen im beisein der eltern oder vormünder sich offentlich mit einander verlobt haben, soll sich niemant unterstehen, durch vertrag oder rezess solche von einander zu scheiden. Kein teil sol auch für sich das ander ledig

> zahlen, sondern was für irrungen und spaltungen in ehesachen fur fallen, sollen die parten in obgedachts consistorium bringen.

But when persons have betrothed themselves publicly to one another in the presence of their parents or guardians, let no man presume to part them from one another by contract or agreement. Neither shall either party of himself count the other free; but whatever errors and divisions fall out in marriage causes, the parties shall bring them before the aforesaid consistory.

**Other orders.** The Prussian consistory order of 1584 punished both parties and the go-between (*Scheidemann*) who arranged a private separation (Sehling 4, p. 133). Calenberg-Göttingen in 1588 forbade pastors and officers to part betrothed couples who had "changed their minds" without weighty cause (Sehling 6/2, p. 884). The Palatine marriage-court order of 1563 (Reformed) punished one who betrothed a second partner without first obtaining the court's release from the first (Sehling 14, p. 301). The Dresden marriage order of 1556 allowed a betrothed person deserted for two years to be "declared free" if the absent party did not answer the citation (Sehling 1, p. 344). No order gives a liturgical form for the release; it was a sentence of the court, which the pastor was bound to see before he proclaimed a new betrothal.

#### 13.7.10 Divorce, annulment and the remarriage of the innocent party

**Divorce.** The orders allowed divorce for adultery and malicious desertion (Matthew 19, 1 Corinthians 7). It was a judgement of the consistory, preceded by an attempt at reconciliation. The Albertine Saxon marriage order of 1556 (Dresden) explained that the court does not part the marriage; the guilty party has broken it, and the court only declares the innocent party free. **Saxony (Albertine), *Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 1, p. 343):

> Wie nun die unschuldige person claget, soll erstlich die reconciliation versucht werden, und so dieselbe nicht erhalten wurd, und die unschuldige person begert, das sie ledig gesprochen werde, sol der richter nach erkundung, ob auch die clagende person ein gut zeugnuss habe, sie ledig sprechen, und zulassen, das sie sich wieder umb in einen christlichen ehestand mit einer andern person begebe, und wurd diese ehe nicht durch den richter zertrennet, sondern durch die schuldige person, die wider gotes willen ihren ehestand selbmutwilliglich zerreist, und in gotes gericht und zorn stelt, aber der richter ercleret nach gotes wort, das die unschuldige person ledig sei

Now when the innocent person complaineth, reconciliation shall first be attempted; and if that be not obtained, and the innocent person desireth to be declared free, the judge, after inquiry whether the complaining person have a good report, shall declare her free and permit her to enter again into a Christian state of marriage with another person. And this marriage is not severed by the judge, but by the guilty person, who wilfully teareth his estate of marriage contrary to God's will and setteth himself in God's judgement and wrath; but the judge declareth according to God's word that the innocent person is free

**Annulment.** A marriage void from the beginning was not dissolved but declared null. The Palatine marriage-court order of 1563 (Reformed), on impotence existing before the marriage, says that the other party is declared free, "which also is properly no divorce, but only a declaration and explanation that between them there hath never been a marriage". **Palatinate, *Ehegerichtsordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 327):

> Hieruf, wha ein ehegemahl vor anfang seiner ehe der natur halben oder sonst zufelligerweiß zu der ehe untuchtig oder ungeschickt ist, alßo das bey rechten, erbarn und gottsfurchtigen leuthen ohne ein wunderwerckh Gottes durch die ordentliche mittel, so unß Gott gegen den vorfallenden unvermuglickhaiten gegeben, nicht zu verhoffen ist, das ihm sein gemahl ihmmer zu ehelichen dinsten daugenlich werde, so khann dasselb khein rechte, naturliche ehe mit einem andern besitzen. Darumb soll das ander ledig gezelt werden, welches auch eigentlich kheine ehescheidung ist, sondern allein ein declaration und erclerung, das zwischen denselben khein ehe nie gewesen sey.

Hereupon, if a spouse be before the beginning of the marriage unfit or unable for marriage by nature or otherwise by accident, so that among right, honest and God-fearing people it is not to be hoped, without a miracle of God, through the ordinary means which God hath given us against such infirmities as befall, that the spouse will ever become fit for the duties of marriage, then such a one can have no right and natural marriage with another. Therefore the other shall be counted free; which also is properly no divorce, but only a declaration and explanation that between them there hath never been a marriage.

**The remarriage of the innocent party.** The church's one liturgical act in divorce came at the remarriage. The innocent party might marry again, but quietly. Brandenburg-Ansbach's marriage court of 1567 required "a quiet church-going and wedding", and the proclamation summoning a deserting spouse was read from the pulpit of the parish where he had lived (Sehling 11, p. 374). Electoral Brandenburg in 1573 gave the procedure: the bill of divorce shown to the pastor four weeks before, no public

banns, and the marriage in the house before two tables of kin. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 3, p. 128):

> Wann sich die unschuldige gescheidene person wider verehelichen will, soll sie dem pfarrer, darunter die hochzeit geschehen solle, den scheidebrief, welchen sie von unsern consistorio erlangt, vier wochen zuvor zeigen und ihnen berichten, das sie sich darauf mit einem andern ehelich versprochen und willens were, sich vortrauen zu lassen, und soll der pfarrer sie nicht öffentlich aufbieten, sondern sich indes sonst mit fleisse erkunden und erforschen, ob andere verhindernus da weren [...] fünde er keine, soll die hochzeit auf einen gelegenen tag angesatzt und dazu etwa zwei tische freundschaft, neben dem priester, geladen werden und die traue im hause ohne alle öffentliche hochzeitliche geprenge geschehen, auf das jederman sehe, das diss nicht eine freie, sondern eine nothsache sei, dadurch dem unschuldigen theil geholfen wirdet.

When the innocent divorced person will marry again, he shall show the pastor under whom the wedding is to take place the bill of divorce which he hath obtained from our consistory, four weeks before, and inform him that he hath thereupon promised himself in marriage to another and is minded to be wedded; and the pastor shall not proclaim them publicly, but shall meanwhile inquire and search diligently whether there be any other hindrance [...] If he find none, the wedding shall be set on a convenient day, and some two tables of kinsfolk, besides the priest, invited thereto, and the marrying done in the house without any public wedding pomp; that every man may see that this is no matter of choice but of necessity, whereby the innocent party is helped.

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## 13.8 The sick, the dying, the condemned and the possessed

The orders handle the sick with private ministry rather than with a fixed rite:

- instruction and comfort;
- private confession and absolution;
- communion in the house.

The medieval "last rites" were dismantled. Extreme unction disappears. The reserved sacrament is no longer carried through the streets: the minister consecrates bread and wine at the bedside. The candle in the dying person's hand is taken away. What remains is the Word, the absolution, the sacrament and prayer. The same pastoral pattern was applied to the condemned criminal and, in Pomerania, to the possessed.

### 13.8.1 Extreme unction

**Abolished.** No evangelical order prescribes the anointing of the sick. The orders give three reasons: it has no command of Christ; the anointing of James 5 belonged to the apostolic gift of healing and cannot now be used "according to St James's meaning"; and it had been turned into a sacrament of the dying. In its place stand the Word, the absolution, the Supper and the prayer of the church, which is what James 5:14–16 actually commands.

**One survival in 1524.** Prior Volprecht's German Mass at Nuremberg in 1524 still allowed "if any at his last end desire the anointing, it shall be given him" (Sehling 11, p. 44). The Ansbach visitors of 1528 already asked the clergy "what the right Christian unction and visitation of the sick may be" (Sehling 11, p. 127).

**Zweibrücken 1539: James 5 read as a visitation.** The Zweibrücken order explains James 5 as the calling of the elders to comfort and pray for the sick, which the church now does with the gospel, the reminder of baptism and the Supper, given in the presence of other Christians. The oil it lets fall. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Form und Ordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 61):

> Von Krancken zu besuchen. Zu den Krancken wurden die Eltesten, das ist die diener der gemein, beruffen, sie zu trosten und gott vor sie zu bitten, davon Jaco. 5: Das gebett des glaubens wurt den Krancken helffen, und der her wurt in auffrichten, und so er hatt sunde gethan, werden sie im vergeben sein. Nu hatt der barmhertzig got das heilig Evangelium zum trost geben denen die sund und todt schreckt und zu verzweiffeln, treibt, und darzu auch die heilige sacrament verordnet. Darumb trosten wyr die Kranken beide mit verkundigung des heiligen Evangeliums und reichung des heiligen sacraments des leibs und bluts Christi, und erynnern sie des entpfangnen tauffs [...] Das oell aber, weil es nit kan nach sanct Jacobs meinung gebraucht werden und sich myßverstandt und mißbrauch zugetragen haben, ist auch kein sacrament noch befelch des herren, laßen wyrs underwegen.

Of visiting the sick. To the sick the elders, that is, the ministers of the congregation, were called, to comfort them and pray God for them; whereof James 5: The prayer of faith shall help the sick, and the Lord shall raise him up, and if he have committed sins, they shall be forgiven him. Now the merciful God hath given the holy gospel for a comfort to those whom sin and death affright and drive to despair, and hath ordained the holy sacraments thereto. Therefore we comfort the sick both with the preaching of the holy gospel and with the giving of the holy sacrament of the body and blood of Christ, and remind them of the baptism they have received [...] But the oil, since it cannot be used according to St James's meaning, and misunderstanding and misuse have arisen, and it is also no sacrament nor commandment of the Lord, we leave aside.

**Lippe 1538: the Gospel instead of the last oil.** The Lippe order has a short chapter "Of the last oil": the oil, used among the Jews for the healthy, was given to the sick without ground in Scripture, and the gospel and Christian prayers are to be read in its place. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 319):

> Von der lesten olye De lestenn olie, so auch ahine grundt gotlicher schrift ingesat den krancken, de tho behoff der gesunden bi den Joden gebruket wort, sal abe sein unnd darvor dat evangelium unnd andere christliche gebeder gelesenn werdenn, dardurch de krancken getrostet unnd im geloven mogen gestercket werdenn.

Of the last oil. The last oil, which hath also been appointed for the sick without ground of divine Scripture, and which was used among the Jews for the behoof of the healthy, shall be done away; and instead thereof the gospel and other Christian prayers shall be read, whereby the sick may be comforted and strengthened in faith.

**Freiberg 1537.** The Albertine visitors at Freiberg ordered in one breath that the sacrament no longer be reserved or carried about, that "the anointing shall henceforth also be done away", and that the sick be communed in German in the presence of others of the household (Sehling 1, p. 466).

#### 13.8.2 No reserved sacrament: communion in the house

**The ciboria broken.** The reserved sacrament was carried through the streets to the sick in procession, with bell and light, and the reformers made this a chief complaint. The Wittenberg consistory in 1542 ordered all ciboria broken up and communion held at the sickbed. **Electoral Saxony, *Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg*, 1542** (Sehling 1, p. 202):

> Item sie sollen darauf achtung geben, damit das heilige sacrament nicht in ciboriis behalten , noch uber die gassen nach papistischem gebrauch getragen, sondern bei den kranken die communion halten, darumb sollen alle ciboria abgebrochen sein und bleiben.

Item they shall take heed that the holy sacrament be not kept in ciboria, nor carried over the streets after the papistical use, but [that they] hold the communion with the sick; therefore all ciboria shall be and remain broken down.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 ("they shall not keep, lock up nor carry about the holy sacrament", Sehling 11, p. 184), Hohenlohe in 1553 and Thomas Stieber's instruction for Wolfstein in 1574 say the same (Sehling 15, p. 77; 13, p. 574). The visitors' order for Belgern ordered the pastor "not to keep the host in the sacrament-house any more, but to consecrate it with the sick" (Sehling 1, p. 525).

**Not a private Mass.** Württemberg in 1536 answered the objection that communion in a house was a "private Mass" (*Winkelmesse*). The minister does not commune himself but gives the sacrament to another, and the sick man "is not excommunicate by reason of his sickness, but rather by reason of the sickness, if he believe, in the communion of all saints". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 111):

> So ist der kranck von seiner kranckheyt wegen nit excommunicatus, sonder ist vilmer von der kranckheit wegen, so er glaubt, in communione omnium sanctorum, darumb gehört ime auch das Sacrament Communionis zu und sol ime zu trost seines gewissens keines wegs verhalten werden.

So the sick man is not *excommunicatus* by reason of his sickness, but is rather by reason of the sickness, if he believe, *in communione omnium sanctorum*; therefore the Sacrament of Communion belongeth to him also, and shall in no wise be withheld from him, to the comfort of his conscience.

The Württemberg order is:

1. 1 Corinthians 11 is read, with a short exhortation.
2. The sick man is heard alone, the others being sent out, and taught and comforted.
3. The general confession and absolution.
4. The consecration with the Words of Institution.
5. Distribution, comfort from the Gospel, and commendation to God.

Reservation outside the sick-call, the Good Friday rite and the consuming of the remaining elements are treated in §§13.20.3–13.20.5.

### 13.8.3 The Saxon form for the sick, 1539

Duke Henry's agenda gives the order most widely copied in the north. Duke August's order of 1580 reprinted it "word for word" (Sehling 1, p. 370). It has three parts.

**Instruction and comfort.** "How sick folk shall be instructed and comforted" is an address in four points:

1. Sickness comes for sin.
2. Christ cleanses us through the Gospel and the sacraments, and will cleanse our nature at the last.
3. Sickness and death are sent in grace, to drive us to repentance and faith.
4. All our sins are laid on Christ.

The address ends: "Der herr ist mein licht, fur wem solt ich mich fürchten? … in deine hende befelhe ich meinen geist" ("The Lord is my light, whom shall I fear? … into thy hands I commend my spirit"; Sehling 1, pp. 269–270).

**Absolution.** It is given in the form for private confession, which ends "Zeuch hin im friede" ("Go hence in peace").

**Communion.** The Saxon order of communion is printed below. **Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Sehling 1, pp. 270–271):

> Wie man die kranken communiciren sol. Wenn der kranke zuvor durch gottes wort unterrichtet, und mit dem wort der absolution getröstet ist, so bereite man den tisch mit brot und wein ehrlich, mit aufgelegtem tuch etc. zu der communio, und wenn solchs geschehen, spreche man dem kranken einen feinen tröstlichen betpsalmen für, als den xxv. Nach dir herr verlanget mich, mein gott, ich hoffe auf dich, las mich nicht zu schanden werden, das sich meine feinde nicht freuen uber mich etc. oder der gleichen kurzer psalmen. Nach dem psalmen lese man dem kranken einen tröstlichen text aus dem evangelio, als ungeferlich diesen. Johannis am 3. Also hat gott die welt geliebet, das er seinen einigen son dargab, auf das alle so an in gleuben, nicht verloren werden, sondern das ewige leben haben. Nach dem evangelio bete man mit dem kranken das vater unser. Und spreche darauf die wort des testaments. Unser herr Jesus Christ [folgen die worte der einsetzung] Solchs thut zu meinem gedechtnis. Auf diese wort reiche man dem kranken den leib des herrn unter dem brot, also sprechend: Der leib unsers herrn Jesu Christi, fur dich in tod gegeben, sterke und beware dich im glauben zum ewigen leben, amen. […] Und auf solche wort reiche man dem kranken denn auch das blut des herrn, also sprechend. Das blut unsers lieben herrn Jesu Christi fur deine sünde vergossen, sterke und beware dich in rechtem glauben zum ewigen leben, amen. Darnach spreche man mit dem kranken den 111. psalm. Ich danke dem herrn von ganzem herzen, im rat der fromen und in der gemeine. Oder an stat des psalmes ein kurzem psalm oder das vater unser. Benedictio. Der herr segne dich und behüte dich. Der herr erleuchte sein angesicht uber dich, und sei dir gnedig. Der herr hebe sein angesicht auf dich, und gebe dir friede, amen.

How the sick shall be communicated. When the sick person hath first been instructed by God's word and comforted with the word of absolution, let the table be made ready with bread and wine honourably, with a cloth laid upon it etc., for the communion; and when that is done, let a fine comfortable psalm of prayer be said before the sick person, as the twenty-fifth: Unto thee, O Lord, do I lift up my soul; O my God, I trust in thee: let me not be ashamed, let not mine enemies triumph over me, etc., or such like short psalms. After the psalm let a comfortable text out of the gospel be read to the sick person, as about this, John 3: For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life. After the gospel let the Our Father be prayed with the sick person, and thereupon the words of the testament be spoken: Our Lord Jesus Christ [the words of institution follow] This do in remembrance of me. Upon these words let the body of the Lord under the bread be given to the sick person, saying thus: The body of our Lord Jesus Christ, given into death for thee, strengthen and preserve thee in the faith unto everlasting life. Amen. […] And upon such words let the blood of the Lord also be given to the sick person, saying thus: The blood of our dear Lord Jesus Christ, shed for thy sins, strengthen and

preserve thee in right faith unto everlasting life. Amen. Thereafter let the hundred and eleventh psalm be said with the sick person: I will praise the Lord with my whole heart, in the assembly of the upright, and in the congregation. Or instead of the psalm a short psalm, or the Our Father. The Blessing. The Lord bless thee and keep thee. The Lord make his face shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee. The Lord lift up his countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. Amen.

The later editions offer shorter psalms (Psalm 125 or 130) and add John 6. After the communion they add Psalms 91 and 117 "if he have repentance and devotion thereto".

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 had the minister hold the same order in church for a single person who could not wait for the Sunday communion: "with such a person one shall deal in the church even as one dealeth with a sick man in the house" (Sehling 11, p. 200). Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg *Agendbüchlein* of 1545 adds a chapter of "cases that befall touching the sacrament with the sick" (Sehling 11, pp. 520–521):

- the godless who will not confess their faith are to be left, "for our Lord Christ forbiddeth hard that one cast pearls before swine";
- the sacrament is never to be given in one kind; rather let the sick die without it;
- for one who cannot take wine, "some advise" a drop or two from the chalice in a drink of water, though such may also rely on the Word and spiritual eating;
- rough folk who have long stayed away are to be brought to repentance and then communicated "without delay";
- those in open vice who will not promise amendment are refused;
- those who cannot keep the sacrament down are to be comforted with the Word until they can;
- those already in their last throes or out of their minds are to be prayed for, but not given the sacrament.

The chapter ends with an exhortation not to save the sacrament for the last need, but to receive it in health.

### 13.8.4 The dying

**Veit Dietrich 1545.** When the end came, Dietrich told the minister not to shout long exhortations into the dying person's ears. He was to kneel, pray the Lord's Prayer aloud with those present, and close with a short collect commending the dying person, "since he was baptized in the name of Jesus". The candle was not to be put into the hand. A crucifix was permitted, but "the best crucifix" is the Word. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 522):

> Im fall, daß der kirchendiener bei dem kranken wer und er jetzund in die züge griffe, da ists nit mer von nöten, den leuten, so zuvor also unterrichtet, lang und vil in die ohren schreien, wie man doch gemeiniglich pflegt, sonder er, der kirchendiener, sol niderknien und andere auch zum gebet vermanen. Erstlich laut ein Vater unser beten und andere im heißen nachbeten […] Es soll auch der kirchendiener oder pfarrherr, kerzen und anders, so man zuvor bei kranken gebraucht, abschaffen, das man es dem kranken nit in die hende gebe; denn weil solches geschehen, das sie damit bekennen sollen, sie wöllen als christen sterben, wissen wir, das die einige und rechte bekentnus ist dise: wenn man Christum Jesum als den einigen mitler und erlöser erkennet. […] Das man ein crucifix bei den sterbenden hat, ist an im selb nit bös. Aber wer den trost im wort hat, der hat das best crucifix, welchs nit allein die augen ansehen, sonder die ohren fassen und das herz in sich bilden kan.

In case the minister of the church be with the sick person and he now fall into the throes of death, it is no more needful to cry long and much into the ears of people who have been so instructed before, as is yet commonly done; but the minister shall kneel down and exhort others also to prayer. First pray an Our Father aloud and bid the others pray after him […] The minister of the church or pastor shall also do away with candles and other things which were formerly used with the sick, that they be not given into the sick person's hands; for since this was done that they should thereby confess that they would die as Christians, we know that the one and right confession is this: when one acknowledgeth Christ Jesus as the only mediator and redeemer. […] That one have a crucifix by the dying is not evil in itself. But whoso hath the comfort in the Word hath the best crucifix, which not only the eyes behold, but the ears grasp and the heart forms within itself.

### 13.8.5 Plague

**Regensburg 1562.** In plague time the orders laid the danger on one minister at a time. Regensburg's order of 1562 made the deacon "of the week" serve all the plague-sick in the pest house, the town and the countryside with the sacrament and God's

Word. He was to keep away from church, baths and gatherings for that week, while the next deacon served the other sick, the baptisms and the rest. **Regensburg, *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit*, 1562** (Sehling 13, p. 435):

> Nachdem erstlich vier diaconi seien, so soll derjenig, der wochner ist, bis auf fernere fursehung eines erbarn rats schuldig sein, alle die, so im lazaret, in der stat und eines rats gebiet mit der schweren krankheit oder pestilenz beladen sind, mit dem hochwirdigen sacrament zu fursehen und si mit Gottes wort zu trösten. Doch soll er sich die selbe wochen in allweg anhaimbs enthalten und nit in die kirchen, offenliche bad oder ladschaften unter die gemain komen, sondern allein den kranken, wie ob gemelt, auswarten.

Since firstly there are four deacons, he that is weekly minister shall be bound, until further provision of an honourable council, to provide with the most worthy sacrament and to comfort with God's word all those who are laden with the grievous sickness or pestilence in the pest house, in the town and in the council's territory. Yet he shall in every wise keep himself at home that same week, and not come among the commons into the churches, public baths or gatherings, but only wait upon the sick, as aforesaid.

**Wittenberg, Halle and Torgau.** Wittenberg's town order of 1533 likewise kept the fourth deacon for the plague-stricken villages "that the other three deacons bring not the pestilence among the people in the town" (Sehling 1, p. 702). The Halle church order (1573?) told the people to confess and receive the sacrament "with healthy body" in time of plague, so as to spare the minister the danger of infected houses (Sehling 2, p. 441). Torgau in 1575 bound every pastor to visit the plague-stricken "unless God should strike his own person" (Sehling 1, p. 683).

#### 13.8.6 The condemned

**Veit Dietrich 1545.** The prisoner condemned to death was the pastor's charge from sentence to scaffold. Veit Dietrich's chapter "How one shall instruct and comfort prisoners condemned to death" was copied by Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1557), Regensburg (1567), Hohenlohe (1578) and others (Sehling 18, p. 28; 13, p. 484; 15, p. 290). It is a pastoral method in two parts:

- **"Terror".** Through the Ten Commandments the condemned is brought to know his sin against God, the magistrate and his neighbour.
- **"Comfort".** The first comfort is for the conscience: God's grace in sending him a minister rather than letting him die "in the fresh deed". The second is against "the shameful death" itself.

It begins with the question why the man lies captive. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, pp. 531–532):

> Wie man gefangene und zum tod verarteilte unterrichten und trösten sol. Zum aller erstem mag man fragen, warumb sie da gefangen ligen. Da würt man dann an der antwort bald merken, wie es umb ir herz steh. Etlicher wird schweigen, nichts bekennen oder sich anheben zu entschuldigen, wie er unschuldig drein kommen etc. Etlicher wurds bekennen, aber doch mit eim trotz. […] Etlicher würds also bekennen, das man an worten und geberden sehen muß, das er seer bekummert, vol leids und jammer sei. […] ist er blöd und forchtig, das man ihn mit Gottes güte und barmherzigkeit tröste, ist er verwegen und trotzig oder ungeduldig, das man im die sünde wol einreibe und ein schrecken in in jage, das er sich erkennen und uber seiner mißhandlung reu und leid lerne haben.

How one shall instruct and comfort prisoners and those condemned to death. First of all one may ask them why they lie there captive. Then by the answer one will soon mark how it standeth with their heart. One will be silent, confess nothing, or begin to excuse himself, how he came into it innocently, etc. Another will confess it, but yet with defiance. […] Another will confess it so that one must see by words and bearing that he is sore troubled, full of sorrow and misery. […] if he be timid and fearful, that one comfort him with God's goodness and mercy; if he be bold and defiant or impatient, that one rub the sin well into him and drive a terror into him, that he may know himself and learn to have repentance and sorrow over his misdeed.

Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 add a chapter on "the instruction and comfort of prisoners condemned to death, and the burial of their bodies" (Sehling 13, p. 170). The Schwarzburg order of 1574 required that the ministers be told three or four days before an execution (Sehling 2, p. 135).

#### 13.8.7 The possessed: prayer instead of exorcism

**Pomerania 1569.** The Pomeranian agenda of 1569 gives the only full evangelical rite for the possessed in the corpus. It forbids exorcism and "devil-banning" "as in the papacy", including the earnest exorcisms that some of "ours" have used. It orders that wandering sextons and others who pass themselves off as devil-banishers be examined by the superintendent and, if need be, punished by the secular arm. The pastor is first to warn the people against believing too readily in possession, "as is often alleged in sickness of the head, with the senseless and raving". Prayer is to be made in the neighbouring parishes. The visit itself runs thus:

1. Two or three ministers go together, having prepared themselves by prayer and fasting.
2. The greeting "The peace of our Lord Jesus Christ be in this house".
3. The Lord's Prayer with a few chosen Christians.
4. The sick man is reminded of his baptism and asked to say the creed and a confession of Christ. "If he can, he is not possessed."
5. If possession is not certain, the physicians are to be called.
6. If it is, there is to be no "pomp" of adjuration: Satan is resisted "with prayers and contempt".
7. A defiance of Satan, the laying of the hand on the sick man's head with the Lord's Prayer, a long prayer to Christ, and the Aaronic blessing in Trinitarian form.
8. On preaching days he is brought to a separate, guarded place in the church, and the congregation prays for him until God turns the need.

**Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, pp. 461–462):

> Wenn men överst spüret, dat de satan dorch gades vorhenkenisse, uns andren tom exempel unde tor boetpredige, vorhanden is, schal men neen geprenge mit beswerende unde der geliken vörnemen: Sed obsistendum est ei orationibus et contemptu satanae, in nomine domini Jesu Christi, dat is, men schal den homödigen satan vorachten, unde sick mit dem gebede im namen unses herren Jesu Christi, wedder en setten […] Hir lege de prester de hand up des kranken hövet unde spreke: Unse vader, de du bist in dem hemmel etc.

But when it is perceived that Satan by God's sufferance is present, for an example to us others and for a preaching of repentance, no pomp shall be undertaken with adjuring and the like: *but he is to be withstood with prayers and contempt of Satan, in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ*, that is, one shall despise the proud Satan and set oneself against him with prayer in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ […] Here let the priest lay his hand upon the sick man's head and say: Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

The chapter ends: "More we cannot do. We must commend the need herewith to God, watch, pray, wait upon the Lord, and not grow weary" (Sehling 4, p. 463).

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## 13.9 Funerals and burial

The evangelical funeral is the medieval funeral stripped of prayer for the dead. Gone are:

- the vigils (the office of the dead);
- the requiem Mass and the Masses of the seventh and thirtieth day and the anniversary (*Siebenter*, *Dreißigster*, *Jahrtag*);
- the sprinkling of holy water and the censing;
- the endowed "soul baths" and "soul gifts" (*Seelbad*, *Seelgerät*).

What remained was:

- the procession to the grave led by the schoolmaster and pupils;
- hymns of faith in the resurrection;
- a lesson or exhortation (usually 1 Thessalonians 4) and a collect;
- increasingly, a funeral sermon in the church.

The orders took great care over who might receive this "Christian burial". To refuse it was a sanction of church discipline.

Funeral sermons are treated in Chapter 11, §11.4.6, and bells for the dead in Chapter 9, §9.5.6.

### 13.9.1 What was abolished

**Vigils and soul-Masses.** The Saxon visitors of 1528 ordered that "soul-Masses and other bought Masses shall no more be held" (Sehling 1, p. 164). The Ansbach diet of 1526 forbade anyone to be "compelled to hold any *Begängnis*, seventh or thirtieth day of a departed person" (Sehling 11, p. 90). Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda opens its chapter on burial by abolishing "all papal pomp with holy water, singing over [the dead] and the rest". **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 528):

> Wie man es mit dem begrebnus halten soll. Bei den leichen, wenn man sie zur erden bestattet, soll alles bebstisch gebreng mit weichwasser, besingen und anderm abgeschaffet sein; denn solches alles nit allein on Gottes wort, sonder auch wider Gottes wort vom bapst angerichtet, als soll es zur seligkeit förderlich sein. Wo nun ein schule ist, da mögen die schuler das Media vita, Nunc dimitis oder ein andern gesang deutsch oder lateinisch singen und mag der kirchendiener oder pfarherr ungeferlich dise kurze vermanung mit solchen oder andern worten bei den begrebnus tun

How one shall hold the burial. At the dead, when they are committed to the earth, all papal pomp with holy water, singing over [them] and the rest shall be done away; for all this hath been set up by the pope not only without God's word but also against God's word, as though it should further salvation. Now where there is a school, the scholars may sing the *Media vita*, the *Nunc dimittis*, or another hymn in German or Latin, and the minister of the church or pastor may make this short exhortation, in these or other words, at the burial

**Müntzer at Allstedt** (Radical Reformation). Even the earliest German orders kept the procession and dropped the vigils. Thomas Müntzer described the Allstedt practice of about 1523–1524. The text stands at the foot of Sehling 1, p. 507, before the visitation order of 1533. The dead were fetched "with the Benedictus in German, without vigils", the people sang *Mitten in dem leben* after the burial, and in church 1 Thessalonians 4 and John 5 were read (Sehling 1, p. 507).

### 13.9.2 The Saxon burial, 1539–1540

Duke Henry's agenda gives the North German pattern.

**1539.** The 1539 text only prescribes the hymn of Simeon, *Mit fried und freud ich far dahin*, or *Mitten wir im leben sind* at the burial.

**1540 and 1555.** The editions of 1540 and 1555 expand it:

1. In towns the schoolmaster and pupils lead the body "honourably"; in the villages the pastor does.
2. A Latin responsory, such as *Si bona suscepimus*.
3. German hymns with the people: *Aus tiefer not*, *Mitten wir im leben sind*, and at the grave the hymn of Simeon; "if there is time", *Wir gleuben all an einen gott*.
4. No sermon is required, but a priest present may close with a collect.

**Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung*, 1539, texts of 1540 and 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 275):

> Wo man schuler hat, lasse man sie erstlich ein latinisch reponsorium singen, als si bona suscepimus etc. Darnach singe das volk mit inen etliche deudsche gesang, als aus tiefer not, mitten wir im leben sind, und bei dem grabe den gesang des heiligen Simeonis, In stedten sollen die leichen ehrlich durch den schulmeister und schuler geleitet werden, nach gelegenheit, mit obangezeigten gesengen, dergleichen aufn dörfern, durch den pfarherr und mit fried und freud etc. item (so man zeit hat) wir gleuben all an einen gott etc. Ist on not, das man bei der begrebnis ein sondere predigt thue, so aber ein priester fürhanden, mag er mit dieser collect beschliessen. Allmechtiger gott, der du durch den tod deines sons die sünd und tod zu nicht gemacht und durch sein auferstehung unschuld und ewiges leben widerbracht hast, auf das wir von der gewalt des teufels erlöset und durch die kraft derselbigen auferstehung auch unsere sterbliche leibe von den todten auferwecket sollen werden, verleihe uns gnediglich, das wir solches festiglich und von ganzem herzen gleuben und die fröliche auferstehung unsers leibs mit allen seligen erlangen mügen, durch denselbigen deinen son, Jesum Christum, unsern herrn, amen.

Where there are scholars, let them first sing a Latin responsory, as *Si bona suscepimus*, etc. Thereafter let the people sing with them some German hymns, as *Aus tiefer not*, *Mitten wir im leben sind*, and at the grave the hymn of holy Simeon. In towns the bodies shall be honourably escorted by the schoolmaster and scholars, as occasion serveth, with the aforesaid hymns; likewise in the villages by the pastor, and with *Mit fried und freud*, etc.; item (if there be time) *Wir gleuben all an einen gott*, etc. It is not needful that a special sermon be made at the burial; but if a priest be present, he may conclude with this collect: Almighty God,

who by the death of thy Son hast brought sin and death to nought, and by his resurrection hast restored innocence and everlasting life, that we, being delivered from the power of the devil, should by the power of the same resurrection have our mortal bodies also raised from the dead: grant us graciously that we may believe this steadfastly and with our whole heart, and obtain the joyful resurrection of our body with all the blessed, through the same thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

**1580.** Duke August's order of 1580 kept this text and added the funeral sermon. After the body has been carried to the churchyard with the ministers and people, and the people have gathered in the church, the minister reads one of the printed sermons that follow, or "if it be specially desired of him" preaches a fitting sermon of his own, and closes with a collect. Model *Leichpredigten* follow, the first on 1 Thessalonians 4 (Sehling 1, p. 371).

### 13.9.3 The Franconian burial: Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533

The Franconian order gives the procession and the graveside exhortation. Where there are scholars and priests they sing:

- the Benedictus, or the "prayer of Moses", Psalm 90 (*Domine, refugium*);
- an antiphon such as *Media vita in morte sumus* or *Ego sum resurrectio et vita*, or a German hymn.

Then an exhortation on 1 Thessalonians 4:13–18 is made, at the house or at the grave. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 203):

> Ir andechtigen lieben brüder und schwestern in dem Herrn, dieweil der allmechtig Gott N., unsern lieben freunde bruder und glid Christi, durch den tod von disem elenden leben in dem rechten, christenlichen glauben (als wir hoffen) zu seiner ewigen rue hat gefordert und hingenummen und wir dardurch zu trauern, klagen und laid zu tragen bewegt werden, auf das wir uns christenlich darin halten, wöllen wir hören die tröstlichen wort des heiligen Pauli, der also spricht [...] Soliche vermanung mag geschehen im haus, da man die leich austregt, oder bei dem grabe, wo am maisten volks darbei ist.

Ye devout, dear brethren and sisters in the Lord: forasmuch as Almighty God hath called and taken N., our dear friend, brother and member of Christ, through death out of this wretched life in the right Christian faith (as we hope) to his eternal rest, and we are thereby moved to mourn, lament and bear sorrow; that we may bear ourselves as Christians therein, we will hear the comfortable words of holy Paul, who saith thus [...] Such exhortation may be made in the house whence the body is carried out, or at the grave, where most people are present.

**The 1591 revision.** The revision of 1591 allowed other texts and "funeral sermons and Christian hymns", and kept the Latin figural music for processional funerals "if specially desired". For "godless and epicurean people" who had not come to church or sacrament for years, or died in drunkenness or rage, it changed the hymns. *Mit fried und freud ich fahr dahin* was not to be sung. Instead *Mitten wir im leben sind* was sung at the door, and penitential hymns on the way (Sehling 11, p. 202, apparatus).

### 13.9.4 Who received Christian burial

**Regensburg 1560.** Burial with hymns, bells and sermon was the church's testimony that the dead had died in the faith, and it could therefore be refused. Regensburg's council set out the principle. The funeral sermon and hymns are "not to be given to every one without distinction as an adiaphoron or worldly thing and friendship". They belong to those who confessed the true doctrine and used Word and sacrament, and not to despisers who died without repentance. These may still be "carried out honourably and laid in the common churchyard … only the ceremonies that belong to Christianity excluded". Suicides are buried outside the churchyard by the executioner. **Regensburg, *Erklärung … welchen … leichpredig und leichgesänge nit mögen zugelassen werden*, 1560** (Sehling 13, p. 448):

> Nachdem leichpredig und leichgesäng so vil auf ihnen haben, das die kirche den verstorbenen damit fur ir glied erkent, ihm damit christlichs lebens und sterbens ir zeugnus gibt, ir selb domit auch so vil auflegt, daß sie mit ihme zu gleichem gericht fur Gott steen will auf eben den glauben, welchen der verstorbene bekant und im leben erzaigt hat (so vil si wais oder wissen kan), so sind die bemelten beede, leichpredig und leichgesang nit jederman also gar one unterscheid mitzutailn als ein adiaphoron oder weltlich ding und freundschaft, sondern Gottes, gewissens und christenlicher zucht halb mit vleiß zu erwegen, wem si mitzutailn oder nit mitzutailn sind. [...] Weil es alzeit fur ein sonderbare, hohe sünde und unbußfertigkait ist geachtet worden, sich selb fursetzlich und verstendiglich zu entleiben, aus was ursachen es sei, so wirdet darauf auch altem herkommen nach fur billich angesehen, das dieselben personen nit auf den gemainen freithof gelegt, sondern außerhalb freitshof dem nachrichter oder schlegel zu begraben oder zu verbrennen bevolhen werden, andern zum schrecken und zum exempel.

Since the funeral sermon and the funeral hymns signify so much, that the church thereby acknowledgeth the departed for her member, beareth him witness thereby of a Christian life and death, and also layeth so much upon herself that she will stand with him at the same judgement before God upon the very faith which the departed confessed and showed in his life (so far as she knoweth or can know), therefore the said two, funeral sermon and funeral hymn, are not to be imparted to every one without distinction as an adiaphoron or worldly thing and friendship, but for God's, conscience's and Christian discipline's sake it is to be diligently weighed to whom they are to be imparted or not. […] Since it hath always been held a peculiar, high sin and impenitence to slay oneself wilfully and knowingly, from whatever cause, it is accordingly also, after old custom, deemed right that such persons be not laid in the common churchyard, but be committed to the executioner or knacker to be buried or burned outside the churchyard, for a terror and example to others.

The same order makes allowance for those who die by accident, drowning or falling. These cases are to be judged one by one.

**Mansfeld 1580.** Mansfeld went further. Heretics, open despisers of the sacraments and those who died impenitent in open vice had always been refused "Christian burial and the customary ceremonies" there. They were not laid with other Christians nor "accompanied with bells or hymns". Pastors were to keep it so. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 246):

> solchen sind bis daher in dieser grafschaft Mansfelt nach gottes wort aus gnugsamen ursachen die christlichen begrebnis und gewönlichen ceremonien, das man sie nicht zu andern christen geleget und weder mit dem geleute oder mit gesengen beleitet hat, abgeschlagen und versaget wurden. Bei solchem brauche sol es auch nochmals erhalten werden.

to such have hitherto in this county of Mansfeld, according to God's word and for sufficient causes, Christian burial and the customary ceremonies been refused and denied, so that they were not laid with other Christians, and were accompanied neither with ringing nor with hymns. By such custom it shall still be kept.

**Children: Brandenburg-Ansbach 1594.** Children were a particular case. The Ansbach consistory noted in 1594 that unbaptized children were not buried with other Christians. It noted too that baptized children under twelve who had not yet communicated were buried in some places with procession and scholars and in others "silently", "whereby Christian parents are not only made sore troubled, but oftentimes the mother, as the weaker vessel, falleth into great temptation". It then laid down a common order (Sehling 11, p. 392). At Soest the theologians' articles provided, as Sehling's editor summarizes them, that no funeral sermon be preached for children who had not yet gone to the Lord's Supper (Sehling 22, p. 380).

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## 13.10 Ordination

The evangelical ordination is a public rite of the church. It confirms a man already examined and called to the office of preaching and the sacraments. It has three parts:

- the prayer of the congregation;
- the reading of 1 Timothy 3 and Acts 20 with the ordinand's promise;
- the laying on of hands by the ordinator and the other ministers, with the Lord's Prayer and a prayer for the Holy Spirit.

**What was dropped.** It drops the vesting, the anointing of the hands and the delivery of chalice and paten, the parts of the medieval rite that conferred the power to offer sacrifice. The Merseburg draft of 1545 names them, "the putting on of the garments, and unction etc.", as "needless, abusive ceremonies, which did nothing for the ordination" (Sehling 2, p. 6). How far the evangelical diaconate was also conferred by ordination is treated in Chapter 16 §§16.5 and 16.8.

**Where it was done.** The orders differ in this:

- **Centrally.** In Saxony ordination was done at Wittenberg or Leipzig before the candidate went to his parish.
- **In the parish.** In Hesse, Lippe and many later orders it was done in the candidate's own parish by the superintendent, joined with his installation (§13.11).

The vows taken at ordination are treated in Chapter 17, §17.4, and the examination and trial sermon before it in Chapter 15, §15.7.3.

### 13.10.1 Why the evangelicals ordained

**The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545.** The first Wittenberg ordination was held in 1535. Ordination had belonged to the bishops, but they had "long persecuted the divine truth". It could not be sought from them while they required an oath to false doctrine. The *Wittenberg Reformation* of 1545 nevertheless kept the door open: if the bishops would accept right doctrine and appoint able examiners, "they could do much good". **Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 211):

> so sind doch die regenten schuldig, ihre arbeit dazu zu thuen, dass man prediger und priester haben möge, und dass die selbigen an gewissen örten von gelehrten gottfürchtigen leuten dazu verordnet, verhöret, angenommen oder verworfen werden. Diese arbeit ist den bischofen befohlen gewesen. Nu haben sie nu lange zeit die göttliche wahrheit verfolget, und lassen die kirchen in ihren eignen gebieten ledig stehen, wüst und heidnisch werden. […] Denn wo sie verfolger christlicher lehr bleiben, und nicht wollen ordiniren ohne verpflichtung zu falscher lehr und zu verfolgung der wahrheit: so kann man die ordinatio bei ihnen nicht suchen.

yet are the rulers bound to do their part thereto, that men may have preachers and priests, and that the same be ordained, examined, accepted or rejected at certain places by learned and God-fearing men. This work hath been committed to the bishops. Now they have for a long time persecuted the divine truth, and let the churches in their own territories stand empty and become waste and heathen. […] For where they remain persecutors of Christian doctrine, and will not ordain without an obligation to false doctrine and to the persecution of the truth, ordination cannot be sought from them.

**Albertine Saxony 1557.** The Albertine general articles of 1557 fixed the places: "The ordination of priests shall be undertaken at Leipzig and Wittenberg, and be done and held in all wise as it hath been customary at those places from the time of the pure evangelical doctrine". The candidate was to be examined in doctrine, asked where he had studied and how he had lived, and made to preach publicly once or more (Sehling 1, p. 322).

#### 13.10.2 The Wittenberg form, 1537–1539

**Sources.** Sehling prints Luther's *Forma der Ordination* of 1537 in what Rietschel held to be its oldest form. His apparatus gives Bugenhagen's expanded Wittenberg text of 1539 and the form Melanchthon gave to two Kulmbach preachers in 1538. After it comes the Latin form "used when foreigners come to seek ordination who do not understand German". Sehling's headnote traces the form into the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1543, Hildesheim, Mecklenburg 1552 and Sarcerius's Mansfeld *Ordinatien form* (Sehling 1, pp. 24–26).

**The rite** is in seven parts:

1. **Prayer before.** After the examination, the congregation is asked in the sermon to pray for the ordinands and the whole ministry.
2. **The hymn.** All kneel before the altar, the ordinator and the presbyters with the ordinands, and the choir sings *Veni sancte spiritus* with the versicle *Cor mundum crea in me, Deus* and the collect of the Holy Spirit.
3. **The lessons.** The ordinator goes up the altar step and reads 1 Timothy 3:1–7 and Acts 20:28–31.
4. **The charge and promise.** He addresses the ordinands: they are not set to keep "geese or cows" but the church bought with God's blood, to feed it with the pure Word, guard it against wolves and sects, and live honestly with their households. Then he asks "Seid ir nu solches zu thun bereit?" ("Are ye now ready to do this?"). They answer "Ja".
5. **The laying on of hands.** With the hands of the ordinator and all the presbyters on the ordinands' heads, the Lord's Prayer is said aloud, then the prayer "Barmherziger gott, himlischer vater … die ernte ist gros" ("Merciful God, heavenly Father … the harvest is great").
6. **The sending.** 1 Peter 5:2–4: "So gehet nu hin und weidet die herde Christi" ("Go ye now therefore and feed the flock of Christ"). In Bugenhagen's text the ordinator then blesses them with the sign of the cross: "Benedicat vobis dominus, ut faciatis fructum multum".
7. ***Nu bitten wir den heiligen geist*** is sung, the Mass follows, and the newly ordained commune first.

The Latin form gives the charge, the question, the laying on of hands and the prayer in one continuous text. **Luther, *Forma ordinationis latina*, 1539** (Sehling 1, p. 28):

> Haec vos facturos esse pro virili, clara voce hic in publico promittite: Dicatis: promitto. Imponite manus. Oremus coniunctis precibus. Pater noster qui es in coelis. […] Clementissime deus, aeterne pater domini nostri Jesu Christi, qui per os dilecti filii tui, domini nostri, Jesu Christi ad nos dixisti „Messis quidem copiosa, operarii vero pauci. Rogate ergo

> dominum messis, ut ipse extrudat operarios in messem suam.“ Huic tuo mandato divino obsequentes toto pectore oramus, ut hisce petentibus ab hac ecclesia confirmationem suae vocationis, et nobis, et universis vocatis ad ministerium verbi tui, spiritum sanctum tuum benigne digneris largiri, quo possimus esse magno numero consociati fideles et constantes ministri evangelii tui, muniti et roborati ope tua et praesidio adversus diabolum, mundum et carnem, ut per nos quamvis indignos et imbecilles, tamen sanctificetur nomen tuum, augeatur regnum tuum, et fiant aliqua tibi grata et multis salutaria. […] Nunc igitur abeuntes iuxta praeceptum Petri apostoli, pascite gregem Christi eum, qui vobis commissus est […] Benedicat vobis dominus, ut faciatis fructum multum. Amen.

That ye will do these things to the utmost of your power, promise here in public with a clear voice: Say, I promise. Lay on hands. Let us pray with joined prayers. Our Father, which art in heaven. […] Most merciful God, eternal Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who by the mouth of thy beloved Son our Lord Jesus Christ hast said unto us, "The harvest truly is plenteous, but the labourers are few. Pray ye therefore the Lord of the harvest, that he send forth labourers into his harvest": obeying this thy divine command, we pray with our whole heart that thou wouldest vouchsafe graciously to bestow thy Holy Spirit upon these who seek from this church the confirmation of their calling, and upon us, and upon all that are called to the ministry of thy word, whereby we may be, joined in great number, faithful and steadfast ministers of thy gospel, fortified and strengthened by thy help and defence against the devil, the world and the flesh, that through us, though unworthy and weak, thy name may yet be hallowed, thy kingdom increased, and some things be done well-pleasing to thee and saving to many. […] Now therefore, going forth according to the precept of the apostle Peter, feed the flock of Christ which is committed to you […] The Lord bless you, that ye may bring forth much fruit. Amen.

The ordinands are said to seek "the confirmation of their calling" from the church. The call comes first, through the congregation and magistrate. Ordination confirms it publicly with prayer.

#### 13.10.3 Ordination within the Mass: Merseburg 1545

**The draft.** When Luther was at Merseburg in 1545, Prince Georg of Anhalt, administrator of the see in spiritual things, drafted the order for the first evangelical ordination there. Sehling summarizes it from the Zerbst manuscript:

1. A sermon explaining ordination and the laying on of hands, and why the vesting and the unction were dropped.
2. A sung Latin Mass: *Veni sancte spiritus*, the introit *Benedicta sit sancta trinitas*, Kyrie and Gloria.
3. A German collect for the ordinands, and the epistle Ephesians 4:7.
4. The *scrutinium*: questions on faith, on heresies, and on life and office.
5. The Alleluia, the Gospel John 20, the Creed, and the *Veni creator* while ordinator and ordinands kneel.
6. 1 Timothy 3 and John 20 read.
7. The commission of "the ministry of the word and the administration of the sacraments, the use of the keys … and authority to ordain others".
8. The laying on of hands by the ordinator and all the priests in turn, with Luther's prayer *Barmherziger gott*.
9. 1 Peter 5, and the blessing with the sign of the cross, received kneeling.
10. The preface, Sanctus, Lord's Prayer and consecration "in the usual manner".
11. The communion of the ordained, with *Ite in orbem* or *Jesus Christus unser heiland*.
12. The *Te Deum*.

**Merseburg, Georg of Anhalt's draft *Ordinations-Ordnung*, 1545, as summarized by Sehling** (Sehling 2, p. 7):

> Ordinator liest text Thimo. 3. 1 und si placet spruch Johannes cap. 20. Und Jesus sprach zu seinen Jüngern: Friede sei etc. „Hierauf befel der ordinator ministerium verbi et administrationem sacramentorum, usurn clavium (etiam si placet) autoritatem alios ordinandi expresse propter astantes.“ (Auflegung der Hände durch Ordinator und alle Priester der Reihe nach.)

The ordinator readeth the text 1 Timothy 3:1, and if it please, the saying John 20: And Jesus said unto his disciples, Peace be unto you, etc. "Hereupon let the ordinator commit the ministry of the word and the administration of the sacraments, the use of the keys (also, if it please) the authority to ordain others, expressly, for the sake of the bystanders." (Laying on of hands by the ordinator and all the priests in turn.)

**Georg as bishop.** Sehling adds that Georg "had himself consecrated bishop on 2 August 1545, and thereafter performed the ordinations in person; in all he ordained 81 preachers" (Sehling 2, p. 8). This, with the ordination by Bugenhagen of Tilemann

von Hussen as the first evangelical bishop of Schleswig in May 1542 (Sehling 23, p. 300), is the corpus's evidence for the consecration of evangelical bishops. The orders print no form for it.

#### 13.10.4 Regensburg 1553: the Spirit as the "true priestly ordination and unction"

The Regensburg *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*, probably by Nikolaus Gallus, opens with the *Veni sancte spiritus* and a defence of the right to ordain. The power of the keys, and with it the power to call and ordain ministers, belongs to the true church. Within the church, "for the sake of order", it is exercised by the ministers. The defence ends with a declaration of what ordination gives. **Regensburg, *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*, 1553?** (Sehling 13, p. 429):

> Wir halten aber die ordination nach apostolischem brauch mit auflegung der hende der priesterschaft und gemeinem gebet, glauben, das dardurch der Heilig Geist geben werde zum ampt, das er durch dasselbig kreftig sein wolle, wie Christus spricht: Nemet hin den Heiligen Geiste usw.; welcher geist die rechte priesterweihe und ölung ist, so gewisse zeugnus der schrift hat und gegeben wird, Gotts word zu predigen und sacrament zu reichen, nit zu opfern für die lebendigen und toten, davon die schrift nichts weis.

But we hold ordination according to apostolic use with the laying on of the hands of the priesthood and common prayer, and believe that thereby the Holy Ghost is given unto the office, that he will be mighty through the same, as Christ saith: Receive ye the Holy Ghost, etc.; which Spirit is the true priestly ordination and unction, which hath sure witness of Scripture and is given to preach God's word and to administer the sacraments, not to offer for the living and the dead, whereof the Scripture knoweth nothing.

The rest of the rite follows this order:

1. **Prayer and lessons.** The Lord's Prayer, then 1 Timothy 3 and Acts 20 with a short exposition.
2. **The vow.** The ordinand vows "in place of an oath" to preach purely according to the prophets, the apostles and the Augsburg Confession, to administer the sacraments as Christ instituted them, and to adhere to no false doctrine: "Ich, N., gelobe hiemit offentlich fur Gott und seiner gemeine, das ich solches alles treulich halten wil. So war mir Gott helfe" ("I, N., vow hereby publicly before God and his congregation that I will faithfully keep all this. So help me God").
3. **The commission**, with the laying on of hands by all the ministers.
4. **A prayer and the blessing** "Gehe hin und bringe viel frucht" ("Go and bring forth much fruit").

**Regensburg, *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe*, 1553?** (Sehling 13, pp. 430–431):

> Darnach legen alle diener die hende auf und wird ihm das ampt solcher weise befolen: So du dann solchs angelobt hast und Christus seiner kirchen befolen, diener des worts zu senden, gleich wie ihn der Vater und er seine lieben aposteln gesendet hat, so geben wir dir jezt kraft desselben befels himit gewalt, zu predigen das evangelium und sacrament zu reichen, wie er spricht: Leret sie halten alles, was ich euch befolen habe, im namen des Vaters und des Sons und des Heiligen Geistes! Amen.

Then all the ministers lay on their hands, and the office is committed to him in this wise: Forasmuch then as thou hast vowed this, and Christ hath commanded his church to send ministers of the word, even as the Father sent him and he his dear apostles, so we give thee now, by virtue of the same commandment, power hereby to preach the gospel and to administer the sacraments, as he saith: Teach them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

#### 13.10.5 Ordination in the parish: Hesse 1574 and the Palatinate 1592

**Hesse 1574** (Philippist). The Hessian agenda of 1574 joins ordination to the first installation of a pastor in his own church. Two or three neighbouring pastors attend as witnesses. The rite runs:

1. A sermon of half to three-quarters of an hour on the office of preacher and hearers.
2. *Kom heiliger Geist*, the superintendent and pastors facing the people and the ordinand facing the superintendent.
3. An address on the vacancy and the lawful call.
4. A long reading on the pastor's office: Matthew 28, Titus 1, 2 Timothy 3–4 and others.
5. A list of the pastor's duties, and the ordinand's vow.
6. The laying on of hands, kneeling at the altar, with the formula below.

7. A prayer, and the commendation of the church to the new pastor and of the pastor to the people.

**Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, pp. 454–455):

> Nach diesem gebet söllen dem ordinando, welcher für dem altar kniend bleibt, die hende aufgelegt werden, und sofl der superintendens oder sein substitut also sagen: So ordene und bestetige ich nun von wegen der kirchen Gottes euch auf euwere getane zusage zum ordentlichen diener der kirchen und lehrer des heiligen evangelii, im namen Gottes des Vaters und des Sohns und des heiligen Geistes. Amen.

After this prayer hands shall be laid upon the ordinand, who remaineth kneeling before the altar, and the superintendent or his substitute shall say thus: So I now ordain and confirm you, on behalf of the church of God, upon your promise made, as an ordinary minister of the church and teacher of the holy gospel, in the name of God the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

Sehling's editor notes that these words are new against the Hessian (Moderate Reformed) tradition of 1539 and 1566 (Sehling 8, p. 454, n. 55).

**The Palatinate 1592.** The Reformed Palatinate used a *Heidelbergische forma ordinationis*. It read 1 Timothy 3 and 4 and Titus 1 and prayed for the Spirit. Then, with the laying on of hands, came a formula close to the Saxon investiture of 1580 (§13.11).
**Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Ordination*, 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 792):

> Nachdem wir nun im namen Gottes versamlet, Gott, unsern himlischen vater, durch Jesum Christum miteinander angerufen und gebeten und nicht zweifeln, daß er uns laut seiner göttlichen zusag gnediglich erhört und gewehret habe, so ordne, confirmire und bestätige ich als ein ordentlicher diener der gemein Gottes euch hiemit zum predigampt und jetzo zu eim diener und seelsorger der christlichen gemein zu N. mit ernstlichem befelch, daß ihr der gemein Gottes ohne ärgernus fleißig und treulich, wie ihr vor Gott schuldig, vorstehet, im namen des vaters und des sohns und des heyligen geysts, Amen. Imponatur manus.

Now since we are gathered in the name of God and have together called upon God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ and prayed, and doubt not that he hath graciously heard and granted us according to his divine promise, I, as an ordinary minister of the congregation of God, ordain, confirm and establish you herewith to the office of preaching, and now to be a minister and pastor of the Christian congregation at N., with earnest charge that ye preside over the congregation of God without offence, diligently and faithfully, as ye are bound before God, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. *Let the hand be laid on.*

**Other forms.** Other orders with their own ordination forms include:

- Pomerania's agenda of 1569, whose first chapter is "How priests shall be ordained in Christian wise to the holy office of preaching" (Sehling 4, p. 421);
- Marbach's Strasbourg order of 1553, where pastors and helpers are examined in the clergy convent and then "confirmed and ordained with laying on of hands and prayer" before the whole congregation on the following Sunday (Sehling 20/1, p. 424);
- the Lippe order of 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 436);
- the Schaumburg order of 1614, which follows "the reading, prayer and laying on of hands" of Luther's form (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 140).

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## 13.11 Installation of pastors, superintendents, abbots and bishops

Ordination happened once, but every move to a new cure needed a public installation. The orders call it variously:

- *Investitur* (investiture);
- *Einweisung* (induction);
- *Präsentation* (presentation);
- *commendiren, einleiben und installiren* (commending, incorporating and installing).

The superintendent, or a neighbouring pastor in his name, came with the patron's or prince's officer. He preached on the ministry, prayed over the new minister and commended the people to him and him to the people. Where the candidate was

newly called, ordination and installation were often one act (§13.10.5). The same pattern served for superintendents and, in Württemberg, for the evangelical abbots of the monastery schools. For evangelical bishops the orders say only that they were ordained "with prayer and the laying on of hands", like other ministers.

### 13.11.1 The Saxon investiture, 1580

**The form and its spread.** The most widely used form was printed in the Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel order of 1569 under the heading "In what wise a new minister of the church shall be commended, incorporated and installed by the superintendents in his church". Sehling's editors note it at Oldenburg 1573 (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1127, n. 2). The same text stands in:

- Lippe 1571 (Sehling 21, p. 438);
- Pfalz-Neuburg 1576 (Sehling 13, p. 173);
- Duke August's Saxon order of 1580, where it is joined to ordination (Sehling 1, p. 382).

**The rite.** The superintendent or his adjunct comes "with the officer, the collator or the lord of the place, together with a neighbouring pastor as witnesses of the act". The rite then runs:

1. *Nun bitten wir den heiligen geist* or *Kom heiliger geist*.
2. A sermon on the ministry of the Word, urging the people to love God's Word and honour its ministers.
3. The Creed sung, during which the superintendent goes to the altar and has the new pastor or deacon kneel.
4. A short address on the lawful choice and call.
5. A collect for the preservation of the ministry, John 20:21–23, 1 Timothy 3:1–7 and Acts 20:28–31.
6. A second prayer, or Luther's ordination prayer "Barmherziger gott".
7. The Lord's Prayer, said or sung.
8. The laying on of the right hand on the bare head, with the formula below.
9. The *Te Deum* or another hymn.

**Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 383):

> Nach dem gebet oder gesang des vater unsers, sol sich der superintendens vor dem altar gegen dem volk wenden, und wie (nach christlicher freiheit, so von dem herrn Christo der kirchen in eusserlichen mittelmessigen ceremonien gegeben) gebreuchlich, sein rechte hand dem neuen pfarrer oder diacon auf sein blos heubt legen, und also sagen. Dieweil wir im heiligen geist versamlet, gott unsern himlischen vater durch Jesum Christum unsern herrn und heiland uber dich angerufen und gebeten, und deshalben nicht zweifeln, er werde uns, laut seiner göttlichen zusagung, gnediglich erhört und gewert haben, demnach so ordne, confirmire und bestetige ich dich, aus göttlichem befehl und ordnung, zu einem diener und seelsorger dieser gemein, mit ernstlichem befehl, das du solcher in warhaftiger furcht gottes ehrlich, ohn alle ergernis, mit höchstem fleis und treuen vorstehen wollest, wie solches einem getreuen hirten der schäflein Christi gebüret, und wie du vor dem gerichtstul unsers herrn Jesu Christi an jenem tag, dem ernsten gerechten richter zur antwort derenthalben stehen, und seines urteils gewarten must, im namen des vaters, und des sohns, und des heiligen geistes, amen.

After the prayer or the singing of the Our Father, the superintendent shall turn before the altar toward the people, and, as is customary (according to the Christian liberty given by the Lord Christ to the church in outward, indifferent ceremonies), lay his right hand upon the bare head of the new pastor or deacon, and say thus: Forasmuch as we, gathered in the Holy Ghost, have called upon God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour over thee and prayed, and therefore doubt not that he will have graciously heard and granted us according to his divine promise: therefore I ordain, confirm and establish thee, by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and pastor of this congregation, with earnest charge that thou preside over it in true fear of God honourably, without any offence, with the utmost diligence and faithfulness, as becometh a faithful shepherd of the sheep of Christ, and as thou must stand before the judgement seat of our Lord Jesus Christ on that day to answer therefor to the earnest and righteous Judge, and await his sentence: in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

**Where it was done.** In the Reuss lordships the newly ordained were "inducted, invested, presented and commended to the people" by the superintendent of each place (Sehling 2, p. 155). In Brandenburg the visitors recorded that a town's pastor, called by the council, had been "confirmed and solemnly invested by the superintendent" at the visitation (Sehling 3, p. 183). Baden in 1556 distinguished two cases (Sehling 16, p. 526):

- a man new to the ministry was "installed by the superintendent before the whole congregation";
- one already in the ministry was only "commended to the church with the ordinary prayer".

### 13.11.2 Presentation in the Reformed Palatinate, 1592

The Palatine *Forma praesentationis* of 1592 (Reformed) puts four questions to the new minister before the congregation, after the sermon and at the place of the Lord's Supper, with the officer present. **Kurpfalz, *Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener*, 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 793):

> Erstlich, ob er das zeugnus des heyligen geistes in seinem hertzen empfinde, das er solchen hohen dienst nicht umb eigen nutzes oder ehr, sondern allein umb der ehrn Gottes und erbauung seiner christlichen kirchen willen begeret? Zum andern, ob er entschlossen, ohn allen falsch und heuchelei die prophetische und apostolische schriften als den einigen, unbeweglichen grundt unser seeligkheit seinen anbevolhenen zuhörern mit höchstem vleis und treu offentlich und insonderheit eines jeden notturft und gelegenheit zu verkündigen und zu ercleren? Zum dritten, ob er auch die h. und hochwürdigen sacramenta unsers herren Jesu Christi nach deßselben stiftung und einsatzung ohn allen menschligen tandt und zusatz raichen und ußthailen wolle? […] Fürs vierdt, ob er durch Gottes gnadt für sich und die seinigen also leben und wandeln wolle, das sich seine zuhörer an ihme nicht zu ergern, sonder zu bessern haben?

First, whether he feeleth in his heart the witness of the Holy Ghost, that he desireth so high a service not for his own profit or honour, but only for the honour of God and the edification of his Christian church? Secondly, whether he be resolved, without all falsehood and hypocrisy, to proclaim and expound the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, as the only immovable foundation of our salvation, to the hearers committed to him, with the utmost diligence and faithfulness, publicly and privately according to each one's need and occasion? Thirdly, whether he will also administer and dispense the holy and most worthy sacraments of our Lord Jesus Christ according to his institution and ordinance, without any human trifling and addition? […] Fourthly, whether he will, by God's grace, so live and walk for himself and his household that his hearers may have no offence in him, but be bettered?

After his "express yes" to each, he is "presented to the church" with a prayer to Christ "who alone awakeneth, calleth and maketh fit such ministers". The same questions, adapted, were put to the lay elders at their installation (see Chapter 16 §16.6.3).

### 13.11.3 The evangelical abbots of Württemberg

**An installation in place of an abbatial blessing.** Württemberg kept its great monasteries as schools for future ministers, with evangelical "prelates" as their abbots. An order of about 1556 for "the presentation and investiture of new prelates" replaced the abbatial blessing with a civil oath and an evangelical installation:

1. **The oath.** On the morning of the installation the new abbot's obligation is read to him by the secretary of the church council. He takes the oath with three fingers of his right hand laid in the Gospel of John.
2. **In the church.** He is led to the abbot's stall. The schoolboys sing German psalms, the Creed or the Lord's Prayer. The provost or a theologian preaches on the ministry and on the true use of monasteries.
3. **The investiture.** *Kom heiliger Geist* is sung. Before the altar the new prelate kneels and is "invested or installed according to the agenda", which is the Württemberg order of 1553. The act ends with "a fine hymn or motet and the blessing".
4. **The presentation.** He is then presented to the school, where the eldest preceptor gives a Latin oration and the pupils give their handfast promise of obedience. Next he is presented to the officials and household of the monastery, and to its subjects, who also give their hands.
5. **The meal.** A breakfast follows, to which the neighbouring pastors are invited.

**Württemberg, *Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten*, after 1556** (Sehling 16, pp. 321–322):

> Würt ime sein Obligation oder Reverß, so vorhin inn gewohnlicher, gemeiner form begriffen unnd uff Pergamen ingrossiert, durch den Kürchenraths Secretarium fürgeleßen unnd volgends ime durch den Probst oder den Theologum, so inn ihren eines Abweßen zum actu verordnet, die Bibel oder new Testament fürgehallten, darein er drey finger der rechten hanndt inn das Evangelium Ioannis legt […] Wann nhun die Predig geendet, singet man: Khum hayliger Gaist, teutsch, unnd geet der Probst oder verordnet Theologus für den Alltar, zu wölchem der Herr Landthoffmeister unnd director oder ihren zwen usser den verordneten Commissariis den newen Prelaten füeren, der vor dem alltar nider knüet

> unnd vermög deß agend Büchlins ordenlich investiert oder installiert unnd endtlich mit einem schon gesanng oder muteten unnd dem Seegen beschlossen würt.

His obligation or bond, drawn up beforehand in the usual common form and engrossed on parchment, is read to him by the secretary of the church council, and thereafter the Bible or New Testament is held before him by the provost or the theologian appointed to the act in his absence, into which he layeth three fingers of his right hand in the Gospel of John [...] When now the sermon is ended, *Kum heiliger Geist* is sung in German, and the provost or the appointed theologian goeth before the altar, to which the Lord Steward and the director, or two of the appointed commissioners, lead the new prelate, who kneeleth down before the altar and is duly invested or installed according to the agenda, and it is concluded at last with a fine hymn or motet and the blessing.

#### 13.11.4 Bishops and superintendents

**No consecration rite.** No order in the corpus prints a rite for consecrating a bishop. The evangelical bishops of Schleswig, Samland and Pomesania, and Merseburg under Georg of Anhalt, were ordained like other ministers.

**Schleswig-Holstein 1542.** The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 makes the ceremonies for bishop and presbyter the same: prayer from the pulpit, a lesson, and prayer with the laying on of hands. The first evangelical bishop, Tilemann von Hussen, was ordained in Schleswig cathedral by Bugenhagen in May 1542 (Sehling 23, pp. 120, 300). **Schleswig-Holstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 23, p. 120):

> Wen he Visitert, mach he erwelde unde tho eme geschickede Prester ordineren, wor he wil; süs anders schal he ordineren tho Slesewick yn syner Kercken. Wo averst unde mit welcken Ceremonien de ordinatio Episcopi et Presbytery schal thoghan, Nömlick mit vorghandem bede vam Predigstole, mit Lection uth der Hilligen Schrifft, mit bede unde upleggінge der hende, Alse de hilligen Apostel hebben gedan, Dat alle schal yn ein sonderlick Bock werden gestellet.

When he visiteth, he may ordain priests that are chosen and sent to him, wherever he will; otherwise he shall ordain at Schleswig in his church. But how and with what ceremonies the *ordinatio Episcopi et Presbyterii* shall be done, namely with prayer going before from the pulpit, with a lesson out of the Holy Scripture, with prayer and laying on of hands, as the holy apostles have done, all this shall be set in a special book.

**Prussia 1568.** The Prussian order of 1568 regulated the election of the bishops of Samland and Pomesania. They were to be chosen "with the good counsel of the bishop then living, of all the princely court and land councillors", with eight deputies of the nobility and eight of the towns and other learned ministers. It confirmed their "spiritual government and full jurisdiction" (Sehling 4, p. 107).

**Superintendents.** The orders give no separate liturgy for installing a superintendent beyond the investiture of §13.11.1. Sehling's introductions record such installations only as events: Jacob Runge, for instance, "was installed into the office of general superintendent of Pomerania-Wolgast" on 7 March 1557 (Sehling 4, p. 323).

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## 13.12 Minor orders, lay offices, church workers and religious communities

#### 13.12.1 The minor orders and the lay offices of the congregation

**No conferral of minor orders.** The evangelical orders did not confer the minor orders (porter, lector, exorcist, acolyte) or the subdiaconate. Their functions passed to sextons, schoolmasters, schoolboys and the deacons of the poor. The full evidence, with the installation of each office, is set out in Chapter 16 §§16.3 and 16.8. In brief:

- **Laying on of hands** was used, besides ministers of the Word, only:
  - for deacons of the poor in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and the London strangers' church (Reformed);
  - for lay elders in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London church and the Palatinate (1592) (both Reformed);
  - for the Bohemian Brethren's clerical deacons.
- **Prayer, a handfast vow or an oath** installed:
  - Reformed elders elsewhere (Kurpfalz about 1601, Hanau 1609, Solms), and the elders of Lutheran Veldenz;
  - Lutheran deacons of the poor in Pomerania;
  - churchwardens.

- **Nothing** is described for the Bohemian acolytes, Lutheran almoners and most churchwardens beyond appointment.

**Three full forms.** Three forms in the corpus install elders and deacons with prayer and the laying on of hands, as a true ordination to a lay office. They are given here in full.

**Hesse 1566: elders** (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian order of 1566 has the elders chosen in each church by its ministers with members of the council and congregation, by vote (Acts 14:23). They are examined on their willingness and then "ordained" in their own church by the superintendent at visitation, or by a pastor with one or two other ministers. The rite runs:

1. A short address, as at the ordination of pastors.
2. The lesson Acts 20:28–31 ("Take heed therefore unto yourselves, and to all the flock").
3. A charge expounding the elders' office in five points:
    - to guard with the ministers against false doctrine and to see that the sacraments are rightly given;
    - to keep the ministers in unity and the congregation free of hatred and schism;
    - to admonish negligent ministers;
    - to exercise the church's judgement: to rebuke the fallen, put the obstinate in the ban, and loose the penitent;
    - to help the ministers in answering questions, reconciling enemies and relieving the poor.
4. The question: will they do all this "before the face of God and of our Lord Jesus Christ and all the elect angels, with the whole congregation here present"? Each answers in turn, as the pastors do at ordination.
5. The people kneel, and the pastor prays.
6. The pastor and the other ministers lay on hands.
7. The charge, "We commit unto you this church".
8. An exhortation to the congregation to receive them with goodwill.
9. Psalm 23, *Der Herr ist mein Hirte*; the blessing; the names entered in the church book.

**Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 209):

> Demnach soll der pfarherr jedermann zum gebet kurzlich vermanen und, wenn sie niedergekniet, ihnen also vorbeten: Almechtiger, ewiger Gott, himlischer Vatter, nachdem dein geliebter Sohn, unser Herr und hoherpriester Jesus Christus verheißen, er wolle allezeit bei uns bleiben bis ans ende der welt, und hat gleichwol den menschen mancherlei gaben verlihen, under diesen aber auch hulf, beistand und gewalt, die kirchen recht zu ordiniren und zu erhalten, so bitten wir demütiglich, daß du dieser deiner diener herzen mit deinem h. Geist begnadigest, lerest und heiligest, uf daß sie mit weisheit und heilsamen rat jederzeit gefaßt, lustig und von herzen diese deine kirch sampt den pfarherrn und eltesten, so im wort arbeiten, treulich und bestendiglich regieren, damit man die geistliche frucht an allen gleubigen volkomlich und uberflüssig spüren möge durch denselben deinen Sohn Christum unsern H. etc. Darauf antworten sie alle: Amen.
> Darnach soll der pfarherr und die andern ministri ihnen die hende auflegen, wie auch zuvor gesagt, etc. Nach dem allen soll man die ordinanden in die mit stellen und ihn die kirch zu versorgen und zu verwalten mit solchen worten befehlen: So befehlen wir euch diese kirch, in welcher ihr zu eltesten seid erwelet worden, daß ihr die herde des Herrn, so er mit seinem blut erlöset, und vom heiligen Geist euch vertrauet ist, wol regiret und gesund behaltet, und daß ihr solchs alles verrichten möget, so seid vorsichtig, habt fleißig acht uf alles, was sich zutregt, seid den dienern des worts in allen dingen behülflich. Wan sie ratschlagen, so handelt weislich und ufrichtig, in vermanungen seid sittig, im straffen allezeit ingedechtig der liebe. Wan ihr urteilet oder richtet, so legt alle menschliche affect von euch; alles, was ihr oder andere vorbringet, das handelt nach der regel des göttlichen worts. Es soll euch nichts heftigers angelegen sein, dan Gottes ehr und die erbauung der gleubigen.

Then shall the pastor briefly exhort every one to prayer, and when they have kneeled down, pray before them thus: Almighty, everlasting God, heavenly Father, forasmuch as thy beloved Son, our Lord and high priest Jesus Christ, hath promised that he will abide with us alway unto the end of the world, and hath nevertheless given unto men divers gifts, and among these also helps, assistance and authority rightly to order and maintain the churches: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest endue, teach and sanctify the hearts of these thy servants with thy Holy Spirit, that they, being at all times furnished with wisdom and wholesome counsel, may gladly and heartily govern this thy church faithfully and steadfastly, together with the pastors and elders which labour in the word; that the spiritual fruit may be perceived in all the faithful fully and abundantly; through the same thy Son Christ our Lord, etc. Whereupon they all answer: Amen. Thereafter the pastor and the other ministers shall lay their hands upon them, as was said before, etc. After all this the ordinands shall be set in the midst, and the church shall be committed unto them to care for and to govern with such words as these: We commit unto you this church, in which ye have been chosen elders, that ye govern well and keep in health the flock of the Lord which he hath redeemed with his blood and

which the Holy Ghost hath entrusted unto you; and that ye may perform all this, be circumspect, take diligent heed to all that befalleth, be helpful to the ministers of the word in all things. When they take counsel, deal wisely and uprightly; in admonitions be modest; in rebuking be ever mindful of love. When ye judge or give sentence, lay aside all human affection; all that ye or others bring forward, handle it according to the rule of the divine word. Let nothing lie more heavily upon you than the honour of God and the edification of the faithful.

**Hesse 1566: deacons** (Moderate Reformed). The deacons of the poor are chosen by the preachers or elders with members of the council and congregation, at least two in each church, and put on probation (1 Timothy 3:10). At their ordination the minister reads them a charge in three points: to show that they have the Holy Ghost by seeking only God's honour; to live honourably and rule their households; and to gather the alms, rents and dues with care, keep them in a register, pay the ministers' wages, relieve the poor in due time, and keep the church fabric in repair. The charge ends with the vow. The laying on of hands follows "with common prayer", on the apostles' example in Acts 6 (Sehling 8, pp. 207–208). **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

> Sollet auch allezeit eingedenk sein, daß ihr nit allein menschen, sondern auch Gottes diener seit, und derwegen nit allein den menschen, sondern auch Gott dem Herrn, der sich nit triegen lesset, von euerm ampt rechenschaft geben müsset. Dies seint der diacon in der gemein Gottes vornemste empter, welche in der heiligen schrift angezeigt sein. Darumb beger ich nun von euch vor dem angesicht Gottes und seiner h. engeln, daß ihr wollet angeloben und zusagen, solchs alles treulich zu halten.

Ye shall also be ever mindful that ye are servants not of men only but of God also, and must therefore give account of your office not to men only but also to God the Lord, who is not deceived. These are the chief duties of the deacons in the congregation of God, which are shewn in the holy Scripture. Therefore I now desire of you, before the face of God and of his holy angels, that ye will vow and promise to keep all this faithfully.

**Hesse 1566: sextons** (Moderate Reformed). The same order has the sextons (*Opfermänner*, *aeditui*, *custodes*) taken on by the pastor and elders with the superintendent's knowledge, with no rite (Sehling 8, p. 211).

**Micron's London order: elders** (Reformed). The Dutch stranger church in London installed both elders and deacons by a public "confirmation" (*bestetigung*) with laying on of hands. Its *Ordinancien* (1554) are printed by Sehling in the East Frisian German edition of 1565. The elders' rite, in chapter 6, runs:

1. After the sermon the elders are set before the congregation. The minister reports from the pulpit that their election was lawful and no hindrance was found.
2. Three questions:
   - Do they feel the witness of the Holy Ghost that they take the office for God's honour and not their own?
   - Do they believe that the prophetic and apostolic doctrine contains all that is needful to salvation?
   - Will they support the ministers, edify the congregation by their life, and submit to Christian discipline if they offend?
3. A prayer to Christ and the Lord's Prayer.
4. The laying on of hands by "the other ministers and the minister of the word", with the blessing quoted below under the Palatinate.
5. Exhortations to the congregation (to pray for the elders) and to the elders (to fear no man, watch over the ministers' doctrine and life, and guard the flock from wolves).
6. A psalm and the dismissal.

**Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 596):

> Herr Jesu Christe, du Sohn des lebendigen Gottes, der du deine gemeine hie auf erden durch den dienst der menschen, darzu ordenlich beruffen, biß ans ende der welt regieren wilst, wir bitten dich demütiglich, du wollest dise menner, unsere brüder (welche zu dem dienst des regiments dieser deiner gemeine erwehlet sind), mit den gaben deines heiligen Geistes dermassen erleuchten, daß sie in ihrem beruff treulich wandlen und denselbigen biß zum ende ihres lebens aufrichtig treiben mögen, zu deiner und deines himlischen Vaters ehre, welchen wir durch deinen namen demütiglich anruffen, wie wir von dir gelehret sind, sprechende: Unser Vater, der du bist in den himlen etc.

Lord Jesus Christ, thou Son of the living God, who wilt govern thy congregation here on earth unto the end of the world by the service of men orderly called thereto: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest so enlighten these men, our brethren (who

are chosen to the service of the government of this thy congregation), with the gifts of thy Holy Spirit, that they may walk faithfully in their calling and carry it on uprightly unto the end of their life, to the honour of thee and of thy heavenly Father, whom we humbly call upon through thy name, as we are taught of thee, saying: Our Father, which art in heaven, etc.

**Micron's London order: deacons.** The deacons' rite, in chapter 7, follows the same pattern "exactly", as the editor notes. The four questions add a vow to gather and distribute the alms "without any respect of persons". The prayer asks Christ, who has commended the poor to us, to "root out all roots of covetousness" and give these men his Spirit "as thou didst of old to Stephen". After the laying on of hands the minister exhorts the rich to give, the whole congregation to sobriety and labour, and the poor to pray for the rich. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 597–598):

> Herr Jesu Christe, der du uns dich selbst in uns armen und unsere armen in dir selbst eigentlich befohlen hast, daß man ein besondere sorge derselbigen in deiner gemeine tragen sol, darzu diaken durch deine aposteln geordnet sind, wir biten [!] dich demütiglich, du wollest alle wurzelen des geizes auß unsern herzen rotten und diesen männern deinen Geist geben, wie du vorzeiten Stephano, deinem ersten mertler, so zu diesem dienst geordnet war, uberflüssig mitgeteilet hast, auf daß sie deinen armen unter uns gottseliglich und treulich dienen in warer liebe one einiges ansehen der personen oder bewegung ihrer affecten […] Wann das gebet volendet ist, werden ihnen die hende aufgelegt, und der diener spricht mit heller stimme also: Gott der Herr und unser himlischer Vater, der euch zu dem dienst der diakeney beruffen hat, der regiere euch gendiglich mit seiner göttlichen kraft, weißheit und gütigkeit, daß ihr in ihm wirdiglich wandlen möget, zu seiner ehren und seiner gemeinen besserung, umb seines eingebornen Sons Jesu Christi, unsers Herren willen. Amen.

Lord Jesus Christ, who hast expressly commended thyself unto us in our poor, and our poor in thyself, that a special care should be had of them in thy congregation, whereunto deacons were ordained by thine apostles: we beseech thee humbly that thou wouldest root out of our hearts all roots of covetousness, and give unto these men thy Spirit, as thou didst of old impart it abundantly to Stephen thy first martyr, who was ordained to this service; that they may serve thy poor among us godly and faithfully in true love, without any respect of persons or motion of their affections […] When the prayer is ended, hands are laid upon them, and the minister saith with a clear voice thus: God the Lord and our heavenly Father, who hath called you to the service of the diaconate, govern you graciously with his divine power, wisdom and goodness, that ye may walk worthily in him, to his honour and the edification of his congregation, for the sake of his only-begotten Son Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

**The Palatinate 1592: elders** (Reformed). The Palatine form of 9 December 1592 for installing the elders "who labour not in the word" is Micron's elders' rite almost word for word: the same report from the pulpit, the same three questions, the same prayer, laying on of hands, exhortations and psalm. No Palatine form for deacons is printed. **Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, pp. 789–790):

> Darnach werden ihnen die händt aufgelegt von den andern dienern und vom diener des worts, welcher spricht mit heller stim also: Gott und unser himlischer vater, der euch mit uns zu dem regiment diser seiner gemeindt (nach der lehr seines worts) berufen und ausgesondert hat, der erleuchte euch auch durch seinen heiligen geist und stercke euch mit der kraft seiner unuberwindtlicher handt, das ihr euern dihnst treulich und bestendig volnfuhren moget zu ehren seines namens und erbauung seiner gemeindt, Amen.

Thereafter hands are laid upon them by the other ministers and by the minister of the word, who saith with a clear voice thus: God our heavenly Father, who hath called and set you apart with us to the government of this his congregation (according to the doctrine of his word), enlighten you also by his Holy Spirit and strengthen you with the power of his invincible hand, that ye may fulfil your service faithfully and steadfastly to the honour of his name and the edification of his congregation. Amen.

#### 13.12.2 Sextons

The sexton (*Küster*, *Opfermann*, *Mesner*, *Sigrist*, *Glöckner*) was chosen with the pastor's and the officer's knowledge and examined in reading, writing, singing and the catechism. He then bound himself to the pastor and parish by a pledge rather than with a rite. The Lippe order of 1571 gives the pledge in full:

- reverence and obedience to the pastor;
- an honest life "as an example to the flock";
- learning and leading the hymns of the feasts;

- opening and locking the church;
- keeping the font filled with clean water;
- keeping church, ornaments and churchyard clean.

It adds a warning against sextons who still dealt in "godless devil's blessings or charms" or wrote out "St John's Gospel" as an amulet. **Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571** (Sehling 21, p. 447):

> Nach solcher Exploration oder erkündigung soll sich der angenommen Küster dem Pastor unnd Pfarleuten obligirn oder verpflichten in massen, wie volgt: Das er gegen seinem Pastor in allen Christlichen und seinem Ampt zugehörigen diensten ohn unlust, murren oder verzug sich willig und bereit finden lasse, Item Im billiche Reverentz und Ehrerbietung erzeigen und beweisen wolle, Auch ein zuchtig, Erbarlich und eingezogen Leben und wandel mit dem Pastor als ein Exemplar gregis füren, Deßgleichen, das er auch die schöne Geistliche Lieder und heilsame, nützliche Psalm von den Fürnembsten Festen und Feyrtagen fleissig lerne und mit rechter andacht dem Volcke vorsinge […] Hierneben sol auch der Küster zu rechter, gewönlicher zeit die Kirchen auff- und zuschliessen, den Tauffstein offt mit reinem, frischem Wasser füllen, die Kirchen und derselbigen Ornamenta, auch Kirchhöfe, seuberlich, reinlich und, wie es sich eigent und gebüret, zierlich halten und verwaren.

After such exploration or inquiry the sexton that is accepted shall oblige or bind himself to the pastor and parishioners in manner as followeth: that he be found willing and ready toward his pastor in all Christian services belonging to his office, without displeasure, murmuring or delay; item, that he will show and prove to him due reverence and respect; also lead a modest, honourable and retired life and conversation with the pastor, as an example to the flock; likewise, that he also diligently learn the fine spiritual songs and wholesome, profitable psalms of the chief feasts and holy days, and sing them before the people with right devotion […] Besides this, the sexton shall also open and lock the church at the right and customary time, often fill the font with clean, fresh water, and keep and preserve the church and its ornaments, and the churchyards also, cleanly, neatly and, as is meet and fitting, seemly.

**Heidelberg 1572: the bell-ringer's appointment and pledge** (Reformed). In the Palatinate the sexton's place was filled by a written appointment (*Bestallung*), to which the appointee answered with a signed pledge (*Revers*). The bell-ringer of the collegiate church of the Holy Ghost at Heidelberg, Philipp Reysing, was appointed on 15 May 1572 by the steward of the church's property. His articles bound him:

1. to take his orders from the ministers, serve the sick as told, and help hear the children in the catechism;
2. to ring for every sermon and stay in church during it, keeping order;
3. to keep the cloths, silver and vessels for the Supper and baptism, received by inventory;
4. to clear out the chests and lumber that hucksters put in the church, and keep the doors clear;
5. to drive out "the wicked boys and other rabble" who soil the pews between sermons;
6. to set up and take down the candles and lanterns, and in plague time and damp weather to fumigate the church with burning juniper;
7. to grease and keep the bells, above all the two great bells and the two choir bells;
8. to keep the royal, electoral and princely tombs clean and locked, and open them only in his own presence.

His wages were 16 florins 15 albus and money for six pounds of hellers from the foundation, three albus for every funeral he rang, three for every wedding, four pence for every baptism in the church, two pence from every house at Christmas, and a house or eight florins' rent. The Bestallung was renewed for his successor Hans Geyer in 1577. **Heidelberg, *Bestallung eines Glöckners*, 15 May 1572** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 457):

> Solle er gute sorg und achtung zu allen glogken haben undt besonder uf die zwo grösten sampt den 2 kohrglögken, welche dem stieft zu erhalten gebüren, dieselben alle monat schmiren und in gutem wesen erhalten. Soll er die konigliche, chur- und fürstliche greber in und ausser dem chor rein und sauber, auch wol verschlossen halten, das die nicht durch unnütz gesindt zergentzet werden. […] Das hat er also angenomen undt demselben getreulich und bestes vleiß nachzukomen versprochen in urkund dieser ime ubergebner bestallung […] Derwegen bekenn ich mich, daß also angenomen haben, und gelobe hiemit mit gueten treuen, diesem meinem dienst, so lang ich darin verharren werde, müglichstes vleis nach einem vermögen abzuwarten und, was mein bestallung inhelt, mir auch sunsten der kirchen wegen befolhen würt, treulich zu geleben undt zu verrichten.

He shall take good care and heed to all the bells, and specially to the two greatest, together with the two choir bells, which the foundation is bound to maintain, and shall grease them every month and keep them in good condition. He shall keep the royal, electoral and princely tombs within and without the choir clean and neat, and also well locked, that they be not defaced by idle rabble. […] This he hath so accepted and promised to perform faithfully and with his best diligence, in witness of this appointment delivered unto him […] Therefore I confess that I have so accepted, and vow herewith in good faith to attend upon this my service, so long as I shall continue therein, with all possible diligence according to my ability, and faithfully to live by and perform what my appointment containeth, and what else is commanded me on the church's behalf.

**The sexton as sacristan.** No order has a separate sacristan; the sexton kept the vessels, vestments, font and lights (see Chapter 16 §16.7.1). His installation therefore took the same forms:

- **A yearly appointment: Anhalt 1594** (Philippist). The village of Törten petitioned for a sexton of its own who could keep school and read in church in the pastor's absence. It agreed a levy for his wages, and the superintendent and the district officer advised on the matter. The prince's court councillors then summoned the whole community and, "with the consent and obligation of them all in common and of each in particular", set down the sexton's office and wages in a written decree. The office itself was granted "for one year only", and the sexton had to sue for it anew with the pastor before every Michaelmas (Sehling 2, pp. 579–580).
- **Surety for the vessels: Sayn 1590.** Because the chalices and ornaments were entrusted to him, no bell-ringer was to be received unless he was "well known" or gave a warrantor or surety (Sehling 19/1, p. 438).
- **Appointment by the parish: Strasbourg 1531** (Moderate Reformed). Vacant offices "of helpers or *Sigristen*" were to be filled "by the pastors and parish churchwardens, and not otherwise" (Sehling 20/1, p. 226).

### 13.12.3 Schoolmasters, cantors and organists

**The schoolmaster's oath.** Schoolmasters, who with their pupils sang the services, were sworn to the council that employed them. Mulhouse's oath of 1551 (Reformed) binds the schoolmaster and his assistant to loyalty to the burgomaster and council, to diligent teaching of their lessons and the catechism, and to a good example. **Mulhouse, *Eid des Schulmeisters*, 1551** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 251):

> Ein schulmeyster unnd sein provisor sollendt schweeren, burgermeyster und rath der statt Mülhusenn, alls irenn herren und obern, jederzyt getreüw, holdt, gehorsam, dienstlich unnd gewertig zusein aller billicher, zimlicher, gerechter dingen […] ires ampts unnd der schulenn zu angesetzter unnd bestimbter zeytt emsigklich zuwarten, uf ir undergebne jungenn ein treüw, flyßigs ufsehenn zuhabenn, ire geordnette lectiones unnd den cathechißmum mit verhörungen der kinder, ordenlichenn und wie sich jederzeytt geburt, hallten

A schoolmaster and his assistant shall swear to the burgomaster and council of the town of Mulhouse, as their lords and superiors, at all times to be faithful, loyal, obedient, serviceable and ready in all fit, seemly and just things […] diligently to attend to their office and the school at the appointed and fixed time, to have a faithful and diligent oversight of the youths committed to them, and to hold their appointed lessons and the catechism, with the hearing of the children, in order and as is fitting at all times

**The Palatinate 1580: the schoolmaster's promise.** The Palatine order of 1580 lists the "chapters on which every schoolmaster received in the Electoral Palatinate shall make promise". He is to remember that he must give account to God for his school; to teach the youth "with all friendliness" Luther's catechism as printed in the church order and no other, and nothing against the Book of Concord; to keep the school hours; to do what his office requires in church as well as school; to live without offence; to obey the church council, superintendent and pastor, answer at visitation and appear before the consistory; to be loyal to the Elector; to bring civil causes before the officers and spiritual causes before the church council; and not to leave his post without leave. The promise closes with handfast, oath and signature. **Palatinate, *Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister … promission thun solle*, 1580** (Sehling 14, pp. 508–509):

> Ihr als ein berufener schulmeister sollt euch allezeit und fleissig erinnern euers berufs und befohlenen schulampts und, daß ihr von wegen desselbigen Gott, dem allmächtigen, rechnung thun werdet. Derowegen sollet ihr die jugendt euerer schulen mit allem fleiß getreulich lehren und underweisen, mit aller freundtlichkeit und holdtseligkeit den catechismum Lutheri, wie der unsers gnedigsten herrn kirchenordnung eynverleibt, wol eynbilden, dabey bleiben und keinen andern in euer schul gebrauchen, deßgleichen wider das christlich Concordibuch nichts lehren […] Dieses alles stät, fest und unverbrüchlich zu halten, auch alles anders zu leisten, was einem getreuen schuldiener und gehorsamen underthanen

> gebürt und wol anstehet, werdet ihr verspruch thun und mit handtgegebner treu angeloben, auch einen leiblichen eydt zu Gott schweren und euch dessen mit eygener underschrift verpflichten und verbinden.

Ye, as a called schoolmaster, shall at all times diligently remember your calling and the school office committed unto you, and that ye shall give account thereof to God Almighty. Wherefore ye shall teach and instruct the youth of your school faithfully with all diligence, and with all friendliness and gentleness impress upon them well the catechism of Luther, as it is incorporated in the church order of our most gracious lord, abide thereby and use no other in your school; likewise teach nothing against the Christian Book of Concord […] All this to keep steadfast, firm and inviolable, and to perform all things else that become and befit a faithful servant of the school and an obedient subject, ye shall make promise and vow with hand given in faith, and swear also a bodily oath to God, and bind and oblige yourselves thereto by your own signature.

**Gengenbach 1536** (Moderate Reformed). The schoolmaster of the imperial town of Gengenbach was bound by his *Bestallung* to obey the council and two councillors and one minister set over him as "school-lords", to live blamelessly, and to follow the class divisions of Freiburg. **Gengenbach, *Bestallung eines Schulmeysters der Statt Gengenbach*, 1536** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/1, p. 483):

> Ein Schulmeyster der Statt Gengenbach soll einem ersamen Rhatt in allen billichen sachen gehorsamen. Auff das erst sollen zwen des Rhats unnd einer uß den dienern der kirchen als schulherren geordnett und sonderlichs uffsehen haben sollen, mit deren Rhat er auch, waß yederzeit der Jugent beßerlich ist, handlen soll. Ein schulmeyster soll onsträfflichs lebens sein, aller beser geselschafft müeßig sten und der Jugent uffß christenlichest, sie christenlichen uffzuziehen, obligen. […] Wie die kirch, also soll auch die schul dahin dienen, das die Jugent in christenlicher kinderleer uffs vleyßigst underricht und also zum himmell, daran es alles ligt, gelert werde.

A schoolmaster of the town of Gengenbach shall obey an honourable council in all fit things. First, two of the council and one of the ministers of the church shall be ordained as school-lords and shall have special oversight, with whose counsel he shall also deal in whatsoever is at any time most profitable for the youth. A schoolmaster shall be of blameless life, keep himself from all evil company, and apply himself in most Christian wise to the youth, to bring them up Christianly. […] As the church, so also shall the school serve to this end, that the youth be instructed most diligently in the Christian children's doctrine and so be taught for heaven, whereon all dependeth.

**Organists: Hildesheim 1581.** No organist's oath is printed in the corpus; Sehling notes one for Öhringen among the Hohenlohe oaths but does not print it (Sehling 15, p. 560). The organist's duties appear instead in contracts. The churchwardens of St Andrew's at Hildesheim engaged Severus Kroschen in 1581 for ten years, to play at Saturday Vespers and at Mass and Vespers on Sundays and feasts, and to keep the new organ in repair. In return he had a free house, sixty thalers a year paid quarterly "like the other ministers of church and school", and corn. **Hildesheim, *Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen*, 1581** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 901):

> das wir den achtparn und ehrhaftigen Seuerus Kroschen aufs neie wiederumb zehen jarlang, von itzt kunftigen Michaelis ahn zu rechnen, zu einem diener und organisten ahngenomen und bestalt haben, folgender gestalt: Das er alle Sonnabent die vesper, des Sontags und andere festage die messe und vesper obberurter kirche schlagen und sich in seinem ampte, wie dan bißhero auch anderst nicht geschehen, christlich verhalten soll. Zudeme soll er darbeneben der neuen orgeln treulich und vleissig furstehen, mit nichten etwaß vorwarlosen oder verseumen, dadurch das werk in schaden geraten und verderben muchte

that we have taken on and appointed the worshipful and honest Severus Kroschen anew for ten years, to be reckoned from Michaelmas next coming, to be a servant and organist after the manner following: that he shall play every Saturday the Vespers, and on Sundays and other feast days the Mass and Vespers of the aforesaid church, and shall behave himself Christianly in his office, as hath not been otherwise hitherto. Moreover he shall also have the charge of the new organ faithfully and diligently, and in no wise neglect or omit anything whereby the work might come to harm and decay

**Cantors.** The cantor was one of the masters of the Latin school (at Hof in 1546 the cantor Georg Hertweg was the schoolmaster's colleague; §13.14.3) and was bound with the school staff. No separate cantor's oath is printed.

The schoolmaster's church duties are treated in Chapter 15, §15.9.

### 13.12.4 Churchwardens and stewards

**Leisnig 1529.** Churchwardens (*Kirchväter*, *Kirchenpfleger*, *Kastenherren*) were elected yearly and sworn. In Leisnig the Saxon visitors of 1529 had two "upright, able, pious men" chosen each year on the Sunday before Michaelmas, by the officer, the pastor, the council and eight deputies of the parish. They were sworn, took over the registers, deeds, stores, cash and keys from the old wardens on Michaelmas Day, and rendered a yearly account. **Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt Leisnig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 609):

> also das alle jar jerlich uf den nechsten suntag fur S. Michels tag durch den ambtman, pfarrer, regirenden rath und die acht personen dem ausschuss, so das gemein kirchspil unter sich zu machen haben, sollen zwene ufrichtige geschickte, frome menner aus den inwonern der stadt zu kirchvetern erwelet, und zu nodturft desselben ambts voreidet. Auf den tag S. Michels sollen alweg die alden kirchveter den nau vorordenten uberantwurten und anweisen alle erbregister, vorschreibung, urkunden, forrat, barschaft

so that every year, on the next Sunday before St Michael's Day, by the officer, the pastor, the council in office and the eight persons of the committee which the common parish hath to make among itself, two upright, able, pious men from among the inhabitants of the town shall be elected churchwardens and sworn as the need of that office requireth. On St Michael's Day the old churchwardens shall always deliver and show over to the newly appointed ones all registers of inheritance, bonds, deeds, stores, cash

**Prussia 1575.** In Prussia in 1575 the churchwardens were "chosen with the pastor's counsel and sworn and confirmed by the patrons" (Sehling 4, p. 153).

**Saxe-Lauenburg 1585: the churchwarden's oath.** Lauenburg gives the oath in the first person. It is followed by the reading of the warden's duties from the church order: to keep a book with copies of all the church's seals and deeds and the originals locked in the church; to record all its lands, rents and dues; and to render account. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 420):

> Eid eines kirchengeschworens. Ich, N., schwere und gelobe gott dem allmechtigen, dass ich in diesem meinem ampte eines kirchgeschworen, darzu ich jtzo ordentlicher weise erwehlet und vorordnet bin, wolle treu und fleissig sein, der kirchen und des pfarrherrn bestes, an dem ihrem unvorseumlich wissen und befodern, und ihren schaden vorhüten, und in diesem ganzen ampte alles, was dem zugehörig ist, getreulich nach meinem besten vormügen und vorstande vorrichten, als mir gott helfe und sein heiliges wort.

The oath of a churchwarden. I, N., swear and vow to God Almighty that in this my office of churchwarden, whereunto I am now orderly chosen and appointed, I will be faithful and diligent; will know and further without neglect the good of the church and of the pastor in what is theirs, and prevent their harm; and in this whole office will perform faithfully all that belongeth thereto, according to my best ability and understanding: so help me God and his holy word.

**The Palatinate 1577: the stewards of church property** (Reformed). The *Kirchenschaffner*, the stewards of the former ecclesiastical property, swore loyalty to their two lords. **Palatinate, *Eid der Kirchenschaffner*, May 1577** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 749):

> Ihr werdet geloben und schweren, meinem gnädigen fürsten und herrn, hertzogen Johann Casimiren, pfaltzgrafen etc., alß euerm castenvogt, schutz- und schirmherrn und landtsfürsten etc., und dem pfaltzgrafen Ludwigen, churfürsten etc., von wegen der halben nutzung der gefel getreu, holdt, gehorsamb und gewertig zu seyn, ihrer chur- und f. gnaden schaden zu warnen und zu wenden, frommen und bestes zu werben und zu fördern, treulich und ohne gefährde.

Ye shall vow and swear to my gracious prince and lord, Duke John Casimir, Count Palatine, etc., as your advocate, protector and defender and prince of the land, etc., and to the Count Palatine Lewis, Elector, etc., by reason of the half share in the revenues, to be faithful, loyal, obedient and ready, to warn and turn away harm from their electoral and princely graces, to seek and further their profit and good, faithfully and without guile.

**Strasbourg 1523: the steward of the poor** (Moderate Reformed). The Strasbourg poor order of 1523 set a *Schaffner* over the alms, who swore to the poor themselves. **Strasbourg, *Armenordnung*, longer version, 4 August 1523** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 113):

> schaffner sol schwören einen eydt liplichen zuo Got unnd den heyligen, den armen luten getruw unnd holt zuo sin, iren nutze unnd frommen zuoschaffen, iren schaden zuowarnen unnd zuowenden, ouch den obgemelten verordenten herren

> unnd nun pflegern gehorsam unnd gewärtig zuo sin unnd den selben umb sin innemmen unnd ußgeben alle fierteil jars ein erbere, uffrechte rechnunge zuothuon

the steward shall swear a bodily oath to God and the saints, to be faithful and loyal to the poor folk, to procure their profit and advantage, to warn and turn away their harm, and also to be obedient and ready to the aforesaid appointed lords and nine wardens, and to render unto them every quarter of a year an honest, upright account of his receipts and expenses

**Wittenberg 1533.** At Wittenberg the six "pious, God-fearing" wardens (*Vorsteher*) of the common chest were appointed and sworn each year by the council and pastor (Sehling 1, p. 708).

**Secretaries.** No oath of a church secretary or clerk is printed. The Dithmarschen privilege of 1605 confirms the parishes' right of election, vocation and appointment (*bestallung*) of "all priests, schoolmasters, sextons, organists, parish clerks" (Sehling 23, p. 509).

### 13.12.5 Midwives

**Lüneburg 1564.** The midwife was in law a minister of baptism (§13.3.7). Many orders therefore had her chosen with the pastor and sworn. Lüneburg in 1564 ordered midwives to be appointed in every district by the officers, the pastor and the church jurors "with the counsel of understanding women". They were bound to use "no idolatry" at the birth but to seek help from God by prayer, and to serve the poor as faithfully as the rich. The pastors were to instruct them in emergency baptism, publicly and privately. **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 557–558):

> so wollen wir erstlich, das von allen ampten jedes orts sampt dem pastor und den kirchschworen mit radt verstendiger frauen allenthalben hebammen verordnet werden sollen, so gottfürchtig, fleissig, treu, düchtig sein und bey jederman ein gut gerücht haben. […] Es sollen auch solche verordente hebammen sich verpflichten, in der not bey den frauen keine abgötterey zu gebrauchen, wie oftermals gespüret, sondern allenthalben alleine bey Gott durchs christliche gebet hülf zu suchen und verordente christliche mittel zu gebrauchen, desgleichen auch verpflichtet sein, bey den armen so fleissig, willig und getreu zu sein als bey den reichen

so we will firstly that by all the offices of every place, together with the pastor and the church jurors, with the counsel of understanding women, midwives be appointed everywhere who are God-fearing, diligent, faithful, able, and have a good name with every one. […] Such appointed midwives shall also bind themselves to use no idolatry with the women in their need, as hath often been found, but everywhere to seek help from God alone by Christian prayer and to use the appointed Christian means; likewise also be bound to be as diligent, willing and faithful with the poor as with the rich

The Ansbach theologians' agreement of 1556 required midwives to be "examined and instructed by the pastors", that they baptize no child unless it be wholly born (Sehling 11, p. 336). At Sangerhausen in 1540 the visitors had the midwives "sworn to the council" (Sehling 1, p. 656).

### 13.12.6 Deaconesses and sick-women

**No ordination of deaconesses.** No order ordains, blesses or installs a deaconess. The word *diaconissa* occurs only at Keppel in 1570, for the convent sister "who distributeth the alms", one of the offices the *domina* assigned among the sisters without any rite (Sehling 10, p. 141; §13.12.8). The women who did the work of the ancient deaconesses were received in three ways:

- **By election and handfast vow.** The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) elected women elders (*presbyterae*) by the free vote of the women, with only women present. The elected bound themselves "by voice and by hand given" and received a place of honour, without laying on of hands (Sehling 4, p. 289). The form is quoted in Chapter 16 §16.6.4.
- **By appointment and examination.** The *Seelfrauen* and sick-women were appointed by the council. Regensburg in 1543 laid down what they were to say to the dying (Sehling 13, p. 410). At Nördlingen the superintendent asked that the women appointed by the council be sent to him to be examined and taught. This examination was their only induction. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 315):

> Hette auch ein erbar weiser rat, wie ich here, etliche weiber darzu verordnet und angenummen, daß si der kranken warten sollten, die, bitte ich, wollen zu mir gewisen werden, auf daß ich mich ires glaubens und verstands, auch, wie si pflegen die kranken zu trösten und dern zu warten, erkundige und, was si nicht wissen, sie leren.

If an honourable, wise council hath also, as I hear, appointed and taken on certain women for this, that they should tend the sick, I pray that they be sent to me, that I may inquire of their faith and understanding, and how they are wont to comfort and tend the sick, and teach them what they know not.

- **By instruction read to them.** Heilbronn in 1531 gathered its beguines into one house and set them to visit the sick and instruct them by God's word (see Chapter 16 §16.7.6). The council's deputies first had each house give its troth "in place of an oath" to declare all its goods for an inventory, and then read the instruction to them. **Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 8 December 1531** (Sehling 17/1, p. 298):

> Zum aller vordersten, die beginnen lassen ir trew an ayds stat geben, das sy alles das jhenig, ir clausen zugehorig, barschafft, klainat, silbergeschirr, gultbrieff, haußrat ob und under erd, nichzit ußgenomen, es sey bey iren handen oder an andern orten, anzuzeigen und gar nichzit verhalten, damit es alles beschriben und inventirt werde. Damit seye nit gemaint, das mans inen nemen oder sy dessen entsetzen wolle, sonder zum pesten iren nutz ain weg wie den andern komen lassen. Und so alles inventiert ist, alsdan sol man inen die instruction furlesen.

First of all, let the beguines give their troth in place of an oath that they will declare, and keep back nothing at all of, all that belongeth to their house: ready money, jewels, silver plate, letters of rent, household stuff above and under ground, nothing excepted, whether it be in their hands or in other places, that it may all be written down and inventoried. Hereby it is not meant that it shall be taken from them, or they dispossessed of it, but that it come to their profit for the best in the one way as in the other. And when all is inventoried, then shall the instruction be read to them.

### 13.12.7 The clothing of a nun: Keppel 1570

**The only evangelical rite of clothing.** The order of Count John VI of Nassau-Dillenburg for the convent of Keppel prints the one complete evangelical form in the corpus for receiving a sister into a convent. Its conditions, set out first (Sehling 10, pp. 135–137), are these:

- the girl must have been brought up in the convent for at least two years and know the Christian doctrine;
- she must be at least twenty years old;
- her parents and kin must deliver a written bond (*Revers*) setting out what she renounces of her inheritance;
- she must bring a hundred gold florins.

**The order of the rite.** The rite itself (Sehling 10, pp. 137–141) runs as follows:

1. **In the convent hall,** at seven in the morning before the sermon, the candidate appears with her parents and kin before the count's officers, the *domina* and the whole convent. The superintendent declares that the count has consented to her clothing and reception, "yet in no other form and manner than our reformation and order bringeth with it".
2. **The order is read** through, except the articles on the election of the *domina*.
3. **Five questions to the parents and kin.** They are asked whether they are content with the order; whether they hold to the doctrine preached; whether they understand that the clothing does not mean that she may never marry or leave the convent, and will help her to an honourable marriage if she wishes; whether she has made any renunciation beyond the bond; and whether they will be thankful to the count and the convent. They promise this "with troth given by the hand", and two noblemen are set as sureties.
4. **Four questions to the *domina*.** Has the girl lived godly, obediently and modestly in the convent? Is the *domina* willing to receive her? Have the parents maintained her? Have the hundred florins been paid?
5. **Five questions to the candidate,** and the oath.
6. **The sermon,** on the true spiritual life, chastity, humility and obedience.
7. **The clothing.** The *domina* and the sisters lead her into the sacristy and put on her the convent's ordinary dress.
8. ***Veni Sancte Spiritus*** is sung before the altar.
9. **The exhortation** at the altar by the superintendent.
10. **The *Te Deum***, with *Benedicamus* and *Deo gratias*.

**The questions and the oath. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 138):

> Die jungfraw soll gefragt werden: 1. Ob sie ungezwungenn sich inn diß closter begebe? 2. Ob sie die hauptstückhe christlicher lehr verstehe unnd bey derselbigen bekhendtnüß mitt Gottes hülff pleiben und sich zu keiner anderer religion nimmermehr begeben wölle? 3. Ob sie unsere ordnung gelesenn, die genugsam erwogen unnd verstanden und in allem

> sich nach derselbigen halten wölle? 4. Ob sie bey iren eltern, brudern oder freunden einigen verzig, heimlich oder offendtlich, gethan oder noch zuthun verheyssenn und zugesagt habe, anderer gestalt als die ordnung inhelt? 5. Ob sie den gewohnlichen eydt vermög der ordnung leisten wölle. […] Form des eydes, so die jungfrawen thun sollen Jungfraw N. etc., ir werdet schwerenn zu Godt unnd seinem heyligen wortt, das ir bey der eynigen, wahren christlichenn religion, der seligmachenden lahr des heyligenn evangelii […] dergleichen bey dem rechtmessigen geprauch der heyligen sacramente nach der stifftung unnd einsatzung unsers herrn Jesu Christi vermittels godtlicher gnaden bestendig pleiben unnd beharren wöllet, euch auch inn disem standt, darinn ir euch ungezwungenn unnd willig begebet, christlich unnd ehrlich haltenn […] euch gegen die matersche unnd den prediger inn allenn godtlichenn, christlichenn, ehrlichen und pillichenn dingenn die zeitt ewers pleybens inn disem closter gehorsam erzeigen, mitt den andern convents persohnen friedtlich und einig leben […] das ir euch auch ohn wissen und rath der obrigkheit, matersche unnd ewerer eltern unnd freundtschafft nicht bestatten oder auß dem closter begeben wöllet, damit alles ordenlich, erbar unnd ehrlich zugehe, alles trewlich unnd ungevarlich, das auch godt helff und sein heyliges wort. Unnd da sie solchenn eydt zuthun willig, soll sie mit ufflegung der rechten handt uff die linckhe brust unnd eigener mundt rede solchen becrefftigen unnd würckhlich leisten.

The maiden shall be asked: 1. Whether she betaketh herself into this convent unconstrained? 2. Whether she understandeth the chief parts of Christian doctrine, and will with God's help abide in the confession thereof, and never betake herself to any other religion? 3. Whether she hath read our order, sufficiently weighed and understood it, and will keep herself according to it in all things? 4. Whether she hath made, or promised and pledged yet to make, any renunciation to her parents, brothers or kin, secretly or openly, otherwise than the order containeth? 5. Whether she will take the customary oath according to the order. […] Form of the oath which the maidens shall take. Maiden N., etc., ye shall swear to God and his holy word that ye will by means of God's grace abide and continue steadfast in the one true christian religion, the saving doctrine of the holy gospel […] and likewise in the right use of the holy sacraments according to the institution and ordinance of our Lord Jesus Christ; that ye will also keep yourselves christianly and honourably in this estate, into which ye betake yourselves unconstrained and willingly […] that ye will show yourselves obedient toward the mother and the preacher in all godly, christian, honourable and reasonable things for the time of your abiding in this convent, [and] live peaceably and in unity with the other persons of the convent […] that ye will also not marry nor betake yourselves out of the convent without the knowledge and counsel of the magistrate, the mother and your parents and kin, that all may be done orderly, decently and honourably; all faithfully and without guile, so help you God and his holy word. And if she be willing to take this oath, she shall confirm and actually perform it by laying her right hand upon her left breast and with words from her own mouth.

**The clothing. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 139):

> Nach der predig sollenn die domina unnd die andere jungfrawen des convents die jungfraw inn die sacristey füeren unnd ir die gewonliche kleyder, wie die andere convents persohnen sonst bekleydet seindt […] anthun. Darnach sollen sie die fur den althar pringen unnd das Veni sancte spiritus singen. Der superintendens aber soll ir ein declaration unnd außlegung ires gethanen gelübdts unnd eydes thun mit underweisung zu einem gottseligen, christlichenn, ehrlichen, tugendtsamen und züchtigen leben unnd vermahnung zu allem pillichenn gehorsam, ungefehrlich uff dise weyse.

After the sermon the *domina* and the other maidens of the convent shall lead the maiden into the sacristy, and put on her the ordinary garments, as the other persons of the convent are otherwise clothed […] Thereafter they shall bring her before the altar and sing the *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. But the superintendent shall make to her a declaration and exposition of the vow and oath she hath taken, with instruction to a godly, christian, honourable, virtuous and modest life and exhortation to all due obedience, after this manner or thereabouts.

**The exhortation.** The superintendent tells the new sister that the true spiritual estate is the one she entered at baptism. She is to beware of thinking that vows and habits earn forgiveness or are better than baptism. The convent is no prison but a school, from which God may call her to marriage, and if so she should marry in an orderly way with her family's help. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 139):

> Ir sollt auch nicht wehnen unnd es darfur halten, das ir hierinnen im closter als inn einen kerkher geschlossenn seyet unnd ewer lebtage darinnen pleiben mussen, oder das die gelubde der keuscheit unnd zucht euch die ehe (darinnen auch keuscheit ist) abschneide unnd verbiete unnd also ewer gewissenn verstrickht, sondern das ir inn keinem andernn stande seyet als sunst andere rechtschaffene christen, so inn der wellt leben, auch ohn allein, das ir gleich als inn einer schulen inn stetiger ubung christlicher andacht inn der lahr, im gebet, gehorsam, zucht, erbarkheit unnd allerley tugenden angehalten werdet, damitt ir hernachmahls, so euch Godt zum ehestandt oder sonst zu etwas anders beruffen

> wurde, ir vilen mitt lahr unnd underweisung auch christlichem wandell und guten exempelln aller tugendten dienen unnd vorgehen kundt

Ye shall also not suppose nor hold that ye are shut up here in the convent as in a prison and must abide therein all your life long, or that the vow of chastity and discipline cutteth off and forbiddeth you marriage (wherein is chastity also) and so entangleth your conscience; but that ye are in no other estate than other upright Christians which live in the world, save only that ye are held, as it were in a school, in continual exercise of christian devotion, in doctrine, in prayer, obedience, discipline, honesty and all manner of virtues; that hereafter, if God should call you to the estate of marriage or to aught else, ye may serve and go before many with doctrine and instruction, and also with christian conversation and good examples of all virtues.

The exhortation ends with a prayer that God "will grant his Holy Spirit both to you and to us all", and the rite closes. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 141):

> Hieruff sollenn die jungfrawen den hymnum Te deum laudamus singen und mit dem Benedicamus und Deo gratias beschliessenn.

Hereupon the maidens shall sing the hymn *Te Deum laudamus*, and conclude with the *Benedicamus* and *Deo gratias*.

**Elsewhere.** The other convent orders put the clothing under the prince or council but print no rite. Lüneburg in 1574 allowed no child or maiden to be "clothed without our foreknowledge and command", and in a plain gown and white kerchief instead of the consecrated cowl, veil and crown (Sehling 6/1, p. 622). Strasbourg in 1555 required a petition to the council and a minimum age of eight (Sehling 20/1, p. 454). Goslar's convent of Frankenberg (1542) and Württemberg (1535) admitted no one (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 275; 16, p. 79).

### 13.12.8 The *domina*, the abbess and the prioress

**Keppel 1570: election, confirmation, oath and presentation.** The convent proposed two or three of its sisters. The count chose and confirmed one, and could depose her if she misbehaved. Before taking office she promised "in place of an oath" to keep the church and other orders, to govern the house faithfully, to hold the sisters to godliness and discipline, to alienate nothing of the convent's goods, to render a yearly account, to eat with the convent, and to tell the count and the kin if any sister meant to leave. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570, "Eydt der dominae"** (Sehling 10, pp. 141–142):

> Die domina soll uns und dem convent an eides statt gelobenn unnd zusagen, das sie bey unsernn christlichenn kirchen- unnd allen andern ordnungen, itzundt ubergeben unnd hernachmahls angestellt und ubergeben werden sollen, inn allen und jedenn punctenn pleiben unnd darob ernstlich und vest haltenn wölle, dem closter trewlich und wol furstehen, ire jungfrawen zu aller gottesforcht, gehorsam, zucht unnd redlicheit zum vleissigstenn anhalten […] unnd endtlich sich für ire person christlich, ehrlich, redlich, züchtig, uffrichtig und unstrefflich inn allen obgesagten stuckhen und articuln halten als ir Gott helff und sein gottlicher nahme.

The *domina* shall vow and promise to us and the convent, in place of an oath, that she will abide by our christian church orders and all other orders, now delivered and hereafter to be set up and delivered, in all and every point, and hold to them earnestly and firmly; govern the convent faithfully and well; hold her maidens most diligently to all fear of God, obedience, discipline and honesty […] and finally keep herself for her own person christianly, honourably, uprightly, modestly, sincerely and blamelessly in all the aforesaid points and articles, so help her God and his divine name.

At her presentation to the convent the superintendent exhorts the sisters to obedience and reminds the *domina* of her "high office and heavy burden". He sets before her St Augustine's rule that the superior should "not exalt herself in her power" but serve in love, and be "loved more than feared" (Sehling 10, p. 142).

**Schleswig-Holstein after 1610: election under oath.** In the noble convents of the duchies the abbess of Itzehoe and the prioresses of the other houses were elected by the whole convent "according to old custom". The electors were sworn in the provost's presence to choose without favour, and the elected bound herself by oath to the convent. Then every sister swore obedience to her. **Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610** (Sehling 23, p. 182):

> so sollen hinfuhro, so offt eine abtissin und priorin abgehet, die vorsamblung nicht nach gunst oder aus neidt gegen den andern oder umb geniesses willen, sondern ohne alle affection einhelligh eine person ihres mittels, die des closters

> gelegenheit weiß und zu dem ambte dauglich ist und demselbigen wie auch dem closter ersprießlich vor sein könne, vermuge eines in ihres probstes gegenwarth geleisteten eydts nach altem gebrauch erwehlen, welche sich dem closter, demselben getreuwlich vorzusein, eydtlich vorpflichten soll. […] Gleichergestaldt sollen auch, so offt ein abtissinne zu Itzehoe oder priorin in den andern clöstern gewehlet wirdt, alle andere jungkfrouwen und hernach ein jede, wann sie zu ihrer hebung kombt, dem alten gebrauch nach eydtlich angeloben, der abtissennen und priorinnen gehorsamb zu sein und sich derselben nicht zuwiedersetzen.

[It is ordained] that henceforth, as often as an abbess or prioress departeth, the assembly shall elect, not for favour or out of envy against others or for the sake of gain, but without any affection, with one accord, a person of their own number who knoweth the circumstances of the convent and is fit for the office, and can be profitable to preside over it and the convent, by virtue of an oath taken in the presence of their provost according to old custom; and she shall bind herself by oath to the convent, to preside over it faithfully. […] In like manner also, as often as an abbess at Itzehoe or a prioress in the other convents is elected, all the other maidens, and thereafter each one when she cometh to her raising, shall vow by oath, according to old custom, to be obedient to the abbesses and prioresses and not to set themselves against them.

**Strasbourg 1555.** In the city's remaining women's houses a "mother" and six "council-mothers", none under twenty-five, were to be chosen from the eldest and fittest. The mother and council-mothers were to "vow" to seek the convent's profit, ward off its harm and see that the sisters lived in christian discipline (Sehling 20/1, p. 456).

#### 13.12.9 Monks, novices and evangelical abbots

**No profession.** No evangelical order admits a monk by profession or vow. Württemberg in 1535 and Goslar in 1542 forbade all admissions and sent unprofessed novices home (Sehling 16, p. 79; 7/2.2, p. 275). Duke Christoph in 1552 forbade the abbots to bind boys "with superstitious ceremonies and vows" to stay in the cloister (Sehling 16, p. 199).

**Novices as scholars: Ravengiersburg 1560.** Where a monastery was kept as a school, a youth was "received" with the prince's and the prior's knowledge and trained for the ministry. The only obligation laid on him was that of a stipendiary. **Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560** (Sehling 19/2, p. 658):

> Wo auch einiger Junger fürhanden, der seins Ingenii und Profectus halben weiter zu schicken, so soll derselbig uff Universitet unser Religion verordnet und nach notturfft erhalten werden. Derselbig, [der] auch so also erhalten wurde, soll sich verpflichten, keinen herrn weiter dann uns und dem Gotshaus zu diehnen.

And where there is any youth who for his wit and progress should be sent further, he shall be appointed to a university of our religion and maintained as need requireth. The same, [who] is so maintained, shall bind himself to serve no other lord than us and the house of God.

**Evangelical abbots.** The Württemberg prelates were invested with an oath, a sermon, *Komm Heiliger Geist*, prayer at the altar and a blessing, and were presented to the school, the officers and the subjects (§13.11.3).

**Monks who stayed.** Esslingen in 1535 (Moderate Reformed) required no rite of the friars who chose to stay, and none of those who left to marry. The council simply gave a settlement to the one and maintenance to the other (Sehling 17/2, p. 382).

#### 13.12.10 Laying aside the habit

**A rite of separation without a rite.** The medieval consecration of virgins gave the nun a blessed veil and crown with the words of the bridal antiphons. When she left, she was said to have lost "the crown of her head". The evangelical orders gave no rite for laying the habit aside. But Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel in 1569 supplied the words with which a sister might answer that reproach. She has not lost her spiritual garment and crown, for she received them in baptism. She lays the cowl and crown aside in God's name, so that no one may think she trusts in them, and so that her sisters "the maidens and wives" take no offence. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 325–326):

> Derhalben wenn eine jungfrau solche klosterkleider sampt ihrer kron hinlegt, kan man zu ihr mit warheit nicht sagen, das sie die geistlichen kleider hingelegt habe, noch viel weniger: Cecidit corona capitis tui, du hast die kron deines breutigams verlorn, sondern sie kans umbkeren und sagen: Eben darumb, das ich mein geistlich kleid rein und unbefleckt, desgleichen die kron auf meinem heupt behalte, die mir in der heiligen taufe angezogen und aufgesetzt worden sind, habe ich die kappen und eusserliche kron hingelegt […] so wil ich im namen des allmechtigen Gottes meine

> kappen, schepler und eusserliche kron von mir legen, auf das meniglich sehen und in dem werk spüren möge, das mirs ernst sey, das ich keine hoffenung der seligkeit darauf gesetzt und solch kleid anderst nicht denn ein ander kleid in meinem herzen halte

Therefore when a maiden layeth down such cloister garments together with her crown, it cannot be said to her with truth that she hath laid down the spiritual garments, much less: *Cecidit corona capitis tui*, thou hast lost the crown of thy bridegroom; but she can turn it about and say: Even for this cause, that I may keep my spiritual garment pure and unspotted, and likewise the crown upon my head, which were put on me and set upon me in holy baptism, have I laid down the cowl and the outward crown [...] so will I in the name of almighty God lay from me my cowl, scapular and outward crown, that every one may see and perceive in the deed that I am in earnest, that I have set no hope of salvation thereon, and hold such a garment in my heart no otherwise than another garment.

**Burial.** Lüneburg in 1574 ordered that no person of the cloister be buried "in cowl, scapular, veil, etc., but in a linen sheet like other Christians" (Sehling 6/1, p. 622).

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## 13.13 Magistrates and civil offices

**No rite in the orders.** The church orders contain no rite for installing a magistrate, swearing in a council or crowning a prince. These acts belonged to the civil constitution of each town and territory, and their oaths and ceremonies are not printed by Sehling. What the orders do contain falls into three groups.

### 13.13.1 The council-election sermon

**Schwäbisch Hall.** Some cities joined the yearly change of council to a sermon on the office of the magistrate. Schwäbisch Hall's order (1543, as revised in 1615) appoints a "special sermon on the office of the magistrate (called the election or council sermon)" every year in St Michael's on the Sunday before St Mary Magdalene. It gives the texts for it. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 165):

> Es soll auch Jährlich am Sontag vor Mariae Magdalenae in der Kirchen zu S. Michel ein sonderliche Predigt vom Ampt der Obrigkeit (die Wahl- oder Raths Predigt genannt) gehalten werden, darbey dann auch die Unterthanen Ihres Ampts zuerinnern, darzu seind sonderliche dienstliche Text Exodi 18; Deut. 16; 2. Par. 19; Rom. 13; Tit. 3; 1. Petri 2 etc.

There shall also be held yearly on the Sunday before St Mary Magdalene in the church of St Michael a special sermon on the office of the magistrate (called the election or council sermon), whereat the subjects also are to be reminded of their office; thereto are especially serviceable the texts Exodus 18; Deuteronomy 16; 2 Chronicles 19; Romans 13; Titus 3; 1 Peter 2, etc.

**Memmingen and Konstanz** (both Moderate Reformed). Memmingen in 1532 had half the churchwardens step down "every year at the new council" (Sehling 12, p. 252). At Konstanz the yearly council election also chose the spokesmen who sat on the city's disciplinary court (Sehling 17, p. 386, editor's note).

### 13.13.2 Prayer for the magistrate

The standing intercession for "the emperor, princes and lords, and all magistrates" in the general prayer of every service was the church's ordinary act toward the civil power. The forms are collected in Chapter 6.

### 13.13.3 Oaths of homage

**Homage oaths.** When a new prince succeeded, all subjects owed him the oath of homage (*Erbhuldigung*), clergy included. The orders mention this only where the clergy's position was in question:

- **Württemberg, about 1563.** The Württemberg instruction for the evangelical prelates printed the homage oath they swore to the duke as protector of their monasteries (Sehling 16, p. 441).
- **The Palatinate, 1585** (Reformed). In 1585 the administrator Johann Casimir ordered the officers to take all ministers and schoolmasters "into the obligation of homage". He gave as the reason that in the Palatinate "even the meanest peasant" did not go without "the customary homage of the land" (Sehling 19/2, p. 756).

- **The Palatinate, 1601** (Reformed). In 1601 the Elector reminded the clergy of the Upper Palatinate that in "political and civil matters" they stood under his officers like other subjects (Sehling 14, p. 590).

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## 13.14 Dedication of churches and the *Kirchweih*

**No consecration rite.** No evangelical order in Sehling contains a rite for consecrating a church, an altar or a churchyard. The bishop's consecration had been one of the episcopal acts that the Reformation lost along with the bishops (§13.10). The orders treat it in two ways: as a superstition to be abolished, and, in one case, as an anniversary to be kept with a sermon on the history of the building. The annual *Kirchweih* (also called *Kirchmesse*, *Kirmes* or *Kirbe*), the dedication festival with its fair, feasting and dancing, was handled as a matter of police: it was restricted, moved off Sunday or forbidden.

### 13.14.1 Dedication rejected

**Homberg 1526** (Moderate Reformed). The Homberg synod forbade the churches to keep dedications at all. There is no stone temple in the church after Christ; the faithful themselves are the living temples. Each believer is to keep the "consecration of the church" in his heart, by thanksgiving for his calling. **Hesse, *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae* (Homberg), 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 50):

> Interdicimus universis ecclesiis nostris in virtute Christi ne ultra dedicationes celebrent, quod non conveniant verbo Domini […] Denique post Christum nullum proprie lapideum templum est in Dei ecclesia, sed soli fideles et ipsa ecclesia sunt viva Dei templa. […] Iam si nullum est templum, profecto illorum dedicatio non est celebranda. Celebret quisque fidelium in corde suo ecclesiae consecrationem, qua sanctius potest, quod toties facit, quoties laetus in Domino de sua et omnium fidelium vocatione gratias agit

We forbid all our churches, in the power of Christ, to celebrate dedications any longer, because they agree not with the word of the Lord […] Finally, after Christ there is in the church of God no temple of stone, properly so called, but the faithful alone and the church itself are the living temples of God. […] Now if there be no temple, then truly the dedication thereof is not to be celebrated. Let every one of the faithful celebrate in his own heart the consecration of the church, as holily as he can; which he doth as often as, rejoicing in the Lord, he giveth thanks for his own calling and that of all the faithful.

**Halberstadt 1588.** The Halberstadt visitation instruction of 1588 made the point within the general rule on ceremonies. Indifferent things (vestments, candles on the altar, Latin or German singing) were to stay as each church had them. But "offensive, superstitious ceremonies, even if they were old", were to be abolished. Among them it names the church dedication and the blessing of the font. **Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588** (Sehling 2, p. 470):

> aber ergerliche abergleubische ceremonien, ob die wol alt weren, soll man abschaffen, als abgöttische bilder, da etwa ein cultus würde angewant, sacrament haus und monstranz, elevatio, adoratio, kirchweihe, taufweihe und dergleichen.

but offensive, superstitious ceremonies, though they were old, shall be abolished: as idolatrous images, where any worship be paid them, the sacrament-house and monstrance, the elevation, the adoration, church-hallowing, font-hallowing and the like.

**Churchyards.** The same reasoning applied to churchyards. The Schwäbisch Hall order, in its funeral sermon, explains that the churchyard is kept honourable and holy for the dead who lie in it, not for any consecration of the ground. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543/1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 175):

> Daß aber die Kirchhöff Ehrlich und Heylig sollen gehalten werden, das ist nit dem Orth selbst und seiner Einweyhung, wie die Widersacher fürgeben, zuzumessen, Sondern geschicht wegen der verstorbenen Leichnam, so darinnen ligen […] Dann nit der Orth den Todten, sondern der Todte den Orth heylig machet.

But that the churchyards should be kept honourable and holy, that is not to be ascribed to the place itself and its hallowing, as the adversaries pretend, but is done because of the bodies of the dead that lie therein […] For the place maketh not the dead holy, but the dead maketh the place holy.

### 13.14.2 Opening a new church or churchyard

**A sermon in place of a rite.** Where a new church or burial ground was brought into use, the orders give no form. What the corpus records are the occasions, and they point to a festal service with a sermon in place of a consecration:

- **Hohenlohe, 1562.** Johann Hofmann preached a "sermon on the right consecration of a churchyard and its church" at the opening of a new cemetery and its church on 16 July 1562. It was printed with his funeral sermons in 1599 (Sehling 15, p. 243, editor's note).
- **Hof, 1546 and 1572.** The two Hof dedications are described in §13.14.3.
- **Colmar, 1575.** The Franciscan church in the hospital at Colmar was "brought to the right use and dedicated" (*eingeweyhet*) for evangelical preaching on 15 May 1575. The deacon David Hiemeyer recalled the first service in a print of 1590 (Sehling 20/2, p. 478, editor's note).
- **Waldenburg, 1591.** The new church at Waldenburg in Hohenlohe was to be "dedicated" on 1 January 1591. Count Georg Friedrich asked for a share of the old Mass vestments and copes of Öhringen "for its adornment" (Sehling 15, p. 431, editor's note).
- **Henneberg, 1635.** The Henneberg consistory reported in 1635 that "when a new church or pulpit is built, the dedication is done by the special superintendent" (Sehling 2, p. 326). This report falls outside the period, and no form is given.

### 13.14.3 Hof: the dedication of 1572 and its yearly festival

**The dedication of 1572.** St Michael's at Hof in the margraviate of Kulmbach is the one evangelical church whose dedication is described with its participants, date and yearly commemoration. The church was rebuilt and "dedicated or entered" (*dedication oder bezihung*) on the eighth Sunday after Trinity, 27 July 1572. The order of 1592 names those who performed it:

- the captain of Hof, Hans Paul von Schaumberg;
- the superintendent, Master Andreas Pangratius;
- Johann Sahr, pastor of the hospital;
- Jacob Schlemmer, schoolmaster, and Laurentius Codomannus, rector of the school.

The order does not print the form used in 1572. It does give the festival by which the dedication was kept every year, and that festival repeats what the 1592 order says was done "in Christian wise" on the day: a procession of the whole town, the sermon on the building, and the dedication Mass and Vespers. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 467):

> Solches alles geschicht der ursach halben, das anno Christi 1572, demnach die schöne pfarrkirchen ad d[ivum] Michaelem ganz und gar ausgebauet und in diese form, so sie izt hat, gebracht, die dedication oder bezihung derselben uf diesen achten sontag Trinitatis, welcher damals war der 27. Julii, ist furgenommen und christlich verrichtet worden, da der gestrenge, edle und ehrenveste Hanns Paulus von Schaumberg allhie haubtman, der ehrwirdige und wolgelerte herr m.Andreas Pangratius p[iae] m[emoriae] superattendens, Herr Johann Sahr p[iae] m[emoriae] pfarrherr im spital, herr Jacob Schlemmer schulmeister und neben ihm herr Laurentius Codomanus (hernach pfarrherr zu Baireuth) scholae nostrae rector gewesen ist. Damit aber solche dedicatio in frischer gedechtnus erhalten und die ursach derselben den leuten zu gewieser zeit eingebildet werde, so ist löblich und wol vom ehrengedachten herren m.Andreas Pangratio angeordnet und seinen herren succesoren hinderlassen, daß sie jerlich begangen und solemniter celebrirt werden soll.

All this is done for this cause: that in the year of Christ 1572, after the fair parish church of St Michael had been wholly built out and brought into the form it now hath, the dedication or entering thereof was undertaken and performed in Christian wise upon this eighth Sunday after Trinity, which was then the 27th of July; when the strict, noble and worshipful Hans Paul von Schaumberg was captain here, the reverend and well-learned Master Andreas Pangratius, of pious memory, superintendent, Master Johann Sahr, of pious memory, pastor in the hospital, Master Jacob Schlemmer schoolmaster, and beside him Master Laurentius Codomannus (afterwards pastor at Bayreuth) rector of our school. But that such dedication may be kept in fresh remembrance, and the cause thereof be impressed upon the people at a set time, it was laudably and well ordained by the aforesaid Master Andreas Pangratius, and left to his successors, that it should be kept yearly and solemnly celebrated.

**The yearly festival.** The rite of the festival runs:

1. **Assembly.** After the second peal the clergy, the council, the whole town and the schoolgirls gather at the Franciscan (cloister) church, the schoolboys at the school.
2. **Procession.** At the full peal the schoolboys, crowned with wreaths, go in through the old cloister door, round behind the stalls under the nuns' gallery and out at the great door, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis*. The whole town follows them in procession to St Michael's. On the way the boys sing *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort*, *Laetatus sum* (Gallus Dressler) and *Laus Deo fonti bonorum*. The schoolgirls and women follow, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr* and *Herr Gott, dich*

*loben wir*. The neighbours strew the lane with grass and set May-boughs on either side "to the honour of God and his church".
3. **Sermon.** The superintendent, in alternate years, either summarizes the Gospel and tells at length the history of the church "from trustworthy old letters, the report of old people and other sure evidence", or summarizes that history and expounds a point of the Sunday Gospel.
4. **Mass and Vespers** with the dedication propers (below).

**Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 467):

> Dominica VIII. Trinitatis, qua celebratur dedicatio templi divi Michaelis. Es wird dieser achte sontag nach Trinitatis, an welchem man das fest der kirchweih zu S.Michaelis zu halten pflegt, mit sonderlichen ceremonien und kirchengebreng begangen, indeme sich der geistliche und weltliche stand sowol die ganze burgerschaft, mann- und weibspersonen, auch die schulmägdlein nach gehörtem andern puls für die closterkirchen (die schuler aber in die schul) versamlen und, wann man zusammen schlegt, mit den schulern (welche als dann mit schönen krenzlein geschmuckt zur tur, da vor alters der creuzgang gewesen, hienein in die closterkirchen, dann hinden umb die stul bei der nonnenporkirchen und zur fördersten grosen tur, neben ihren praeceptorn widerumb hinausgehen, singende: Sei lob und ehr mit hohem preis) in einer ordentlichen procession, wie droben bei dem pfingstmontag auch gedacht, in sanct Michaelis oder die pfarrkirchen sich verfügen und allda des gottesdienst abwarten.

The eighth Sunday after Trinity, on which is celebrated the dedication of the church of St Michael. This eighth Sunday after Trinity, on which the feast of the church-hallowing at St Michael's is wont to be kept, is observed with special ceremonies and church pomp: in that the spiritual and the temporal estate, and also the whole burghership, men and women, and the schoolgirls also, after the second peal is heard, gather before the cloister church (but the scholars in the school); and when all the bells are rung together, with the scholars (who then, adorned with fair wreaths, go in at the door where of old the cloister walk was, into the cloister church, then round behind the stalls by the nuns' gallery and out again at the foremost great door beside their masters, singing *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis*), they betake themselves in an orderly procession, as is said above at Whit Monday also, into St Michael's or the parish church, and there wait upon the divine service.

**The propers.** The order gives the music of the *Officium dedicationis templi*. It keeps the texts of the old Mass and Office of a church's dedication in polyphonic settings:

- **Introit:** *Terribilis est locus iste*, followed by a Mass of Georg Forster.
- **After the epistle:** *Verba mea auribus percipe* (Lassus).
- **After the Gospel:** *Levavi oculos meos* (Lassus).
- **In place of *Nun bitten wir*:** *Benedic, Domine, domum istam* (Johannes de Hollande).
- **At Vespers:** the antiphon *In domum Domini ibimus*, Psalm 116 (*Dilexi*), the responsory *Si bona suscepimus*, the hymn *O lux beata*, and *Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort* in place of the Magnificat (Sehling 11, p. 468).
- **In the psalter of the Office:** for the feast of the dedication, the antiphon *In domum Domini laetantes ibimus* with Psalm 84, *Quam dilecta tabernacula* (Sehling 11, p. 422).

**The school dedication of 1546.** The same order describes a second dedication at Hof, kept yearly on Whit Monday with the same kind of procession. Margrave Albrecht gave the empty Franciscan friary to the town in 1543 for a school. Its "dedication", set for 1545, was put off by plague. On Whit Monday 1546 the town went in procession from the parish church to the cloister church, and after the service the schoolmaster and his colleagues led the boys into the new school, where the superintendent exhorted them. Each year the town walked, with the schoolboys in wreaths (the lower classes in the white shirts their godparents had given them), from St Michael's to the cloister church singing *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, *Apparuerunt apostolis* and *Sei Lob und Ehr*. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 464):

> in welchen man uf vorbemelten pfingstmontag aus der pfarrkirchen eine procession in die closterkirchen gehalten und nach verrichtetem gottesdinst Herr Jacob Schlemmer, schulmeister […] neben seinen zweien collegen als Georgen Hertweg, cantorn, und Wolfgang Döberlein, baccalaureo […] die schuler in die neue schul geführt, sie in gegenwart des herren Leonhardi Eberhardi als pastoris und superattendentis zu allem gutem vermahnet und dann nach wenig tagen ihre exercitia darinnen zu verrichten angefangen haben.

in which, upon the aforesaid Whit Monday, a procession was held out of the parish church into the cloister church; and after the divine service was done, Master Jacob Schlemmer, schoolmaster […] together with his two colleagues, namely Georg Hertweg,

cantor, and Wolfgang Döberlein, bachelor [...] led the scholars into the new school, exhorted them to all good in the presence of Master Leonhard Eberhard as pastor and superintendent, and then after a few days they began to do their exercises therein.

**Regensburg, about 1567.** Regensburg kept a comparable anniversary. On the Sunday after 15 October the choir sang figural music "on account of the dedication of the temple". That day marked the beginning, in 1542, of evangelical preaching and the Lord's Supper in the church (Sehling 13, p. 475). There was no consecration; the festival commemorated the Reformation of the church.

#### 13.14.4 The *Kirchweih* festival

**A police matter.** The popular *Kirchweih* survived the abolition of the rite. Most orders handled it only as a problem of police: the feasting, drinking and dancing, and the fairs that kept people from the Sunday sermon. Three degrees of severity appear:

| Treatment | Examples |
|---|---|
| Moved off Sunday or kept behind the sermon | Mecklenburg 1552: no *Kirchmessen* or fairs on Sunday (Sehling 5, p. 220); Hesse 1571 (Philippist): the Landgraves' instruction proposed Monday (Sehling 8, p. 359, editor's note); archbishopric of Bremen (Vörde) 1577: no booths opened until sermon and service were over (Sehling 7/1, p. 24) |
| Tolerated with limits | Saxony 1580: one day of dancing at each village *Kirmes*, by daylight (Sehling 1, p. 442); Nassau-Weilburg 1609: dancing at customary *Kirmes* and fairs once or twice a year, for an hour or three (Sehling 10, p. 339) |
| Abolished outright | Baden 1548 and 1564 (Sehling 16, pp. 518, 537); Waldeck 1583; Hohenlohe 1586 (Sehling 15, p. 521), with Schwäbisch Hall the same year (Sehling 15, p. 587, editor's note); a Palatine police ordinance (Sehling 14, p. 66, editor's note); Solms 1582 and 1594 (Reformed; Sehling 9, pp. 325, 337). Hohenlohe in 1579 forbade the clergy to go to one another's *Kirchweih* (Sehling 15, p. 380) |

**Waldeck 1583.** Waldeck's mandate of 1583 is typical. The festivals "derive from the papacy" and breed "all wantonness and levity". They had already been abolished in the neighbouring electorates, principalities and counties, and the pastors were to announce the abolition from the pulpit on two Sundays. **Waldeck, *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste*, 8 August 1583** (Sehling 9, p. 299):

> Nachdem wir uß relation unserer kirchenvisitatorn berichtet, daß uff den kirmessen, welche uß dem bapsthumb herruren undt von unsern underthanen biß noch behaltten werden, alle uppigkeitt undt leichtfertigkeitt zuwidder Gottes heiliges wortt undt gebotten getrieben, gehegt undt furtgesetzt werden [...] undt wir derowegen solche kermisse, die vorlengst in unsern benachpartten chur- undt furstenthumben graff- undt herschafften abgeschafft, auch nitt lenger undter unsern underthanen zu dulden undt zu gestatten wissen

Whereas we are informed by the report of our church visitors that at the church-ales, which come from the papacy and are kept by our subjects until now, all wantonness and levity is practised, cherished and carried on contrary to God's holy word and commandments [...] and we therefore know not to suffer and permit any longer among our subjects such church-ales, which have long since been abolished in our neighbouring electorates and principalities, counties and lordships

**Danzig 1612.** In 1612 Danzig noted in its list of the sexton's fees that the church's dedication festival, with three feasts of Mary, was "now no longer held for a great feast, nor kept" (Sehling 4, p. 206). Mulhouse in 1524 (Reformed) had already struck the dedication feast of Basel minster from its calendar (Sehling 20, p. 163, editor's note).

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### 13.15 Blessings of objects and their abolition

**The medieval blessings.** The late medieval church year carried a cycle of blessings of things:

- holy water and salt every Sunday, with the sprinkling (*Asperges*);
- candles at Candlemas;
- ashes on Ash Wednesday and palms on Palm Sunday;
- the new fire, the paschal candle and the font on Holy Saturday;
- the Easter basket (*Fladen*, eggs, meat) on Easter Day;

- herbs at the Assumption;
- St John's wine (*Johannisminne*) on 27 December;
- bells "baptized" against storms.

The chrism and holy oils were consecrated by the bishop on Maundy Thursday.

**Uniform abolition.** No evangelical order kept any of these blessings. They are abolished in almost the same words from the Pomesanian bishop's articles of 1524 to the end of the century. The grounds are always the same three:

- the creatures are already sanctified by God's word at creation and by thanksgiving (1 Timothy 4:4–5);
- there is no command or promise of God for the blessing;
- the blessed things had become means of "superstition and sorcery".

What survived were the bare actions where they served preaching or prayer: the Sunday procession without water, bell-ringing as a call to prayer, the chrism at baptism in two orders. The wreath survived as a civil sign of honour, not a blessed object.

### 13.15.1 The lists of abolished blessings

**Pomesania 1524.** The earliest list is in the articles which Erhard von Queiss, bishop of Pomesania, published at the end of 1524. **Pomesania, *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*, 1524** (Sehling 4, p. 29):

> Es soll forthin kein wasser, salz, asche, palmen, lichte, kräuter und dergleichen geweihet werden; denn das ist alles menschentandt und ist nirgends zu nütze.

Henceforth no water, salt, ashes, palms, candles, herbs and the like shall be hallowed; for it is all men's toys and profiteth nowhere.

**Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.** The fullest list is in the Pfalz-Neuburg order of 1543, which follows Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 203). It goes through the year feast by feast. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 96–97):

> Man sol auch nicht mer weihen oder segnen weihwasser und salz, wie alle sonntag beschehen, noch wachs zu Lichtmeß noch aeschen am Aschermitwoch noch palmen am palmtag noch osterstock noch tauf noch feur am osterabent noch fladen, eier, fleisch am Ostertag noch wurz oder kreüter Assumptionis Mariae noch wein an S. Johannis des evangelisten; dann solche segen sein dem wort Gottis alle ungemeß und zuwider, zum teil auch abgöttisch und dienen mer zu abeglauben dann zur gotseligkeit

Neither shall men any more hallow or bless holy water and salt, as was done every Sunday, nor wax at Candlemas, nor ashes on Ash Wednesday, nor palms on Palm Sunday, nor the Easter candle, nor the font, nor fire on Easter Eve, nor cakes, eggs, flesh on Easter Day, nor roots or herbs at the Assumption of Mary, nor wine on the day of St John the Evangelist; for such blessings are all unagreeable and contrary to the word of God, in part also idolatrous, and serve more to superstition than to godliness.

**The reasons.** Nassau-Dillenburg's order of 1537 sets out the reasons at length. Pastors are not merely to stop blessing but to teach the people why. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Sehling 10, p. 76):

> Es sollen auch die pfarhern unnd kirchenndhiener hinfuro weder saltz, feur, liecht, obs, kraut nit meher weihen, aber doch das volck furhien underrichten, warumb solichs pillich unnderlassen werde. Dan solich creaturen seint von Gott gut beschaffen, ein jegliche aber zu irem gebrauch, Ge[nesis] 1, unnd seint von Gott gehailiget unnd geweihet, den glaubigen mit dancksagung zugeniessen, 1. Timo. 4, darumb bedurffen sie unnsers weihens nit […] wo ist ein wort Gottes, das da sage, das weywasser hinweckneme oder abwesch die tegliche sunde, erquick die selen auff dem kirchoff, vertreibe den teuffel aus den heussern, item das geweihet kraut oder geweihet liecht unnd palmen dienen widder das ungewitter?

The pastors and ministers of the church also shall henceforth no more hallow salt, fire, light, fruit, herb, but shall nevertheless instruct the people why this is rightly left off. For such creatures are created good by God, each one for its use, Genesis 1, and are sanctified and hallowed by God, for the faithful to enjoy with thanksgiving, 1 Timothy 4; therefore they need not our hallowing […] where is there a word of God that saith that holy water taketh away or washeth off daily sins, refresheth the souls in the churchyard, driveth the devil out of houses; item, that hallowed herb or hallowed light and palms avail against the tempest?

**Further lists.** The same list, shorter or longer, recurs throughout the corpus:

| Order | Blessings named | Sehling |
|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 | St John's blessing, wax, palms, fire, *Fladen*, salt, water, herbs | 11, p. 203 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg 1537 | salt, fire, light, fruit, herbs; holy water, palms | 10, p. 76 |
| Freiberg 1538 | water, salt, *Fladen*, roots, palms, oats | 1, p. 467 |
| Brandenburg 1540 | water and salt, Sunday sprinkling, herbs, candles | 3, p. 88 |
| Saxony (Albertine) 1540 | sprinkling, salt and water | 1, p. 285 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 | salt, water, herbs, palms, *Fladen* | 6/2, p. 799 |
| Merseburg 1544 | water, salt, light, roots | 2, p. 13 |
| Hohenlohe 1553 | as Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 | 15, p. 76 |
| Lüneburg convents 1555 | palms, Easter candle, water, fire (blessed by the prioress) | 6/1, p. 615 |
| Thüngen 1564 | waters, salt, herbs, candles, "St John's Gospel" | 11, p. 740 |
| Wolfstein 1574 | water, fire, herbs, fruit, *Fladen*, eggs, bacon, meat | 13, p. 574 |
| Teschen 1584 | candles, herbs, water, salt | 3, p. 460 |
| Halberstadt 1588 | water, fire, salt, herbs (visitation question) | 2, p. 470 |

**Calenberg-Göttingen 1542.** Calenberg-Göttingen gives the shortest form of the argument. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 799):

> Vom salz-, wasser-, kraut-, palmen- und fladenweihen. Weil alle creaturen reichlich und gnungsam durchs wort zur zeit der schepfung gesegnet und geweihet sein und hie vom gleubigen weiter nichts gefordert wird, dan das er dieselbigen mit danksagung und wol brauche, 1. Timo. 4, so sol solch weihen, weils in der schrift keinen grund hat, ganz abgeschafft sein.

Of the hallowing of salt, water, herbs, palms and cakes. Since all creatures were richly and sufficiently blessed and hallowed by the word at the time of the creation, and nothing further is here required of the believer but that he use them well and with thanksgiving, 1 Timothy 4, therefore such hallowing, since it hath no ground in Scripture, shall be wholly abolished.

**Lüneburg convents 1555.** The Lüneburg convent reform of 1555 shows how long the blessings could survive inside the cloister. The prioress (*domina*) had for a time been blessing the palms, the Easter candle, water and fire herself. This "did not belong to her", and was to stop (Sehling 6/1, p. 615).

### 13.15.2 What was kept in place of the blessing

**Brandenburg 1540.** Electoral Brandenburg abolished the blessings but kept the Sunday procession round the church, now without water, with a pure responsory or a seasonal hymn. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 88):

> Das wasser- und salzweihen, samt dem sontaglichen sprengen, dergleichen kreuter, lichter und anders zu weihen, sol vorbleiben, denn es keinen göttlichen befelch hat und zu grossem misbrauch und zauberei geraten, aber der sonteglich circuitus mit einem reinen responsorio oder anderm gesange, wie es die zeit gibt, und mit nachlassung obbemelter misbreuch sol bleiben.

The hallowing of water and salt, together with the Sunday sprinkling, and likewise the hallowing of herbs, candles and other things, shall be left off, for it hath no divine command and is turned to great abuse and sorcery; but the Sunday procession, with a pure responsory or other chant as the season giveth, and with the leaving off of the abuses aforesaid, shall remain.

### 13.15.3 The blessing of the font

**Font blessing abolished.** The solemn blessing of the font on Holy Saturday and the eve of Pentecost, with the chrism and the paschal candle, was dropped everywhere. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg articles of 1528 already said that "blessing of the font shall be left off, since we have neither command nor example for it in Scripture". The people were to be taught why before it was stopped (Sehling 11, p. 136). Bugenhagen's Lübeck order of 1531 put the reason in a phrase: "water is water, blessing is blessing" (Sehling 5, p. 354). The water in which a child is baptized is ordinary water, and the word of institution makes the sacrament (§13.3.1).

### 13.15.4 Chrism and holy oils

**Chrism dropped.** The chrism and the oils, which only a bishop could consecrate, disappeared with the post-baptismal anointing (§13.3.2) and extreme unction (§13.8.1). The *Straßburger Kirchenampt* of 1525 (Moderate Reformed) said that oil, chrism and "the enchanted water" were no longer used at baptism, because the people trusted in them (Sehling 20, p. 153). Luther's Saxon visitors in 1528 would not quarrel over the chrism: "the right chrism, with which all Christians are anointed by God himself, is the Holy Ghost" (Sehling 1, p. 158).

**Kept by two orders.** Two orders kept the chrism at baptism as an "ancient ceremony" with a teaching meaning: Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 and Pfalz-Neuburg in 1543, which copied it. Brandenburg explained that the anointing signified the royal priesthood of Christians. The people were to be taught that the Holy Ghost, not the chrism, anoints, and children baptized in emergency were not to be anointed afterwards (Sehling 3, p. 54; quoted in §13.3.2). Neither order says who consecrated the chrism. In Pfalz-Neuburg Ottheinrich suspended the chrism section and issued a new baptismal order (Sehling 13, p. 22, editor's note). When he succeeded to the Palatinate in 1556 he ordered baptism "without chrism" (Sehling 14, p. 112).

### 13.15.5 Bells and weather-ringing

**Bell baptism.** Bells were "baptized" with chrism and salt and named. The rung bell was believed to drive off storms, hail and the demons in them. The evangelical orders never blessed a bell. They divided over the ringing itself.

**Saxony 1528.** The Saxon *Unterricht der Visitatoren* of 1528 (repeated in 1539) let weather-ringing continue, re-explained as a call to prayer. Between the two passages quoted it explains that God sends storms as punishment and good weather as his gift (Leviticus 26, Deuteronomy 28). The passage (with the whole end of its chapter) is missing from the edition of 1538, according to Sehling's apparatus. **Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, pp. 170–171):

> Dieweil aber das selbige leuten hernachmals misgebraucht, und dafür gehalten ist worden, das die glocken, und villeicht umb des willen, das man eine zeitlang fürgenomen die selben zu weihen, das wetter vertreiben solten, were nicht böse, das die prediger in sommerzeit, das volk vermaneten, so sich ungewitter hebet, und wo man leutet, das solche gewonheit darümb gehalten werde, nicht das der glocken dohn und weihung der glocken das wetter oder frost vertreibe, wie bisher geleret und gehalten ist worden, sondern das man dadurch erinnert würde, gott zu bitten, uns die früchte der erden behüten. […] Wenn nu das leuten abgethan, so würde villeicht das volk deste weniger erinnert, das von gott das wetter kömpt, und rüfet gott deste minder an. Es würden auch die leute deste wilder, wenn sie nicht vermanet werden, gott umb leben und narung zu bitten. Doch mus das der prediger viel bas ausrichten, denn die glocken, sonst würde ein teufelstreudel daraus, wie zuvor gewest.

But since the same ringing was afterwards misused, and it was held that the bells (and perchance for this cause, that men had for a time undertaken to hallow them) should drive away the weather, it were not amiss that the preachers in summertime admonished the people that, when a storm ariseth and men ring, this custom is kept to this end: not that the sound of the bells and the hallowing of the bells driveth away the weather or the frost, as hath been taught and held hitherto, but that men be thereby reminded to pray God to preserve us the fruits of the earth. […] If now the ringing were done away, the people would perchance be the less reminded that the weather cometh from God, and would call upon God the less. The people would also grow the wilder if they were not admonished to pray God for life and sustenance. Yet the preacher must do this far better than the bells, else a devil's game would come of it, as it was before.

**Saxony 1580.** The later Saxon order of 1580 abolished weather-ringing outright, because of the bell baptism behind it. **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 453):

> Sonderlich aber sol das aberglaubisch und abgöttische wetterleuten, (der ursach die glocken im babsthumb mit lesterlichem missbrauche der stiftung Christi getauft werden, das sie die kraft haben sollen, den hagel und schedliche

> wetter abzuwenden) wo das noch im brauch, abgeschaffet und nicht gestadtet, dargegen aber das volk zur buss und christlichem eiferigem gebete vermanet werden

But especially shall the superstitious and idolatrous weather-ringing (for which cause the bells in the papacy are baptized, with blasphemous misuse of Christ's institution, that they may have the power to turn away hail and harmful weather), where it is still in use, be abolished and not permitted; but instead the people shall be exhorted to repentance and to Christian, fervent prayer.

**Hohenlohe 1582.** Hohenlohe in 1582 kept a middle way. The people had been taught that "bell baptism is a horrible misuse of holy baptism, a blasphemy". One bell might be rung moderately as a call to prayer, but not all bells together nor for as long as the storm lasted (Sehling 15, p. 452).

**Other territories.** Other territories ended weather-ringing by mandate:

- Coburg 1554/55 (Sehling 1, p. 544, cited by the editor);
- Thüngen 1564 (Sehling 11, p. 741);
- Pfalz-Neuburg 1560 and 1576 (Sehling 13, pp. 139, 194);
- the Upper Palatinate 1557 and 1579, which in 1579 allowed one bell at night "to rouse and exhort the people to prayer" (Sehling 13, pp. 296, 316);
- Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 310);
- Ysenburg-Birstein 1583 (Sehling 10, p. 616);
- Limpurg 1610, which regulated it (Sehling 16, p. 623).

Weather-ringing among the other uses of the bells is treated in Chapter 9, §9.5.8.

#### 13.15.6 Wreaths and other signs

**Wreaths.** The bridal wreath was not blessed but survived as a sign of honour. It was withheld from a bride who had lost her virginity (§13.7). At Hof in 1592 the schoolboys walked crowned with wreaths in the dedication procession (§13.14.3).

**Popular survivals.** Rural police ordinances dealt with surviving popular rites as superstition rather than liturgy, including the Easter and St John's fires and the use of "St John's Gospel" as a charm (§13.12.2): Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (Sehling 10, p. 310), Hesse 1608 (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 61) and the Thüngen order.

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### 13.16 The ban, excommunication, public penance and reconciliation

**The medieval ban rejected.** The evangelical orders began by rejecting the medieval ban, which was pronounced by officials for debts and fees and enforced by interdict. The Pomesanian articles of 1524 declared that "henceforth there shall be no ban which burdens consciences without ground in God's word and compels by human ordinance alone" (Sehling 4, p. 29).

**Matthew 18 and 1 Corinthians 5.** In its place almost every order set up a scriptural ban on the pattern of Matthew 18:15–17 and 1 Corinthians 5. The steps were:

1. private admonition;
2. admonition before witnesses;
3. report to the church (the consistory, the superintendent or the elders);
4. exclusion.

Exclusion was in two grades:

- **The lesser ban** (*kleiner Bann*, *separatio*, *excommunicatio minor*): exclusion from the Sacrament and from standing as godparent, without public announcement.
- **The greater ban** (*großer Bann*, *excommunicatio major*): public exclusion from the congregation, "delivering to Satan", with civil consequences.

The return was by public penance (*öffentliche Buße*, *Kirchenbuße*) and absolution before the congregation.

**Who could ban.** The orders differ chiefly on who held the power:

- **Lutheran consistories.** In the Lutheran territories the consistory decided and the pastor pronounced. The consistory was a court of theologians and jurists acting for the prince.
- **Hesse (Ziegenhain 1539)** (Moderate Reformed). Hesse set elders beside the pastor, and the ban was pronounced before them "and for the time being not before the whole congregation" (Sehling 8, p. 108).
- **The Reformed.** In the Reformed orders the power lay "not with one or several ministers" but with the whole congregation, exercised through elders: the Palatinate 1563 (Sehling 14, p. 388) and the London stranger church (Micron), both Reformed.

### 13.16.1 Lesser and greater ban

**Grubenhagen 1581.** Grubenhagen distinguished ordinary church discipline from the ban proper. The public rebuke of open sinners and their quiet refusal at confession "is no excommunication or ban, but a reminder to repentance". The ban is final. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1052):

> Es ist aber zum dritten ein unterscheid zwischen gemeinen kirchenstraffen und der excommunication oder bann; denn die offentliche straffe der offenbaren sünder sampt der heimlichen abweisung vom sacrament, so in der beicht oder sonst geschicht, ist keine excommunication oder bann, sondern eine erinnerung zur busse und hinlegung des gegebenen ergernis. Der bann aber ist eine endliche ausschliessung der verstockten von der christlichen gemein und ubergebung dem sathan zum verderben des fleisches

But thirdly there is a difference between the common punishments of the church and excommunication or the ban. For the public rebuke of open sinners, together with the secret turning away from the sacrament which taketh place in confession or otherwise, is no excommunication or ban, but a reminder to repentance and to the putting away of the offence given. But the ban is a final shutting out of the obdurate from the Christian congregation, and a delivering to Satan for the destruction of the flesh.

**Lauenburg 1585: the lesser ban.** Lauenburg names the grades. After the general preaching of the law and private admonition by the pastor and superintendent, the obstinate sinner is turned away from the Supper, from standing godparent and from leading a bride. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 448):

> sol man einen solchen halsstarrigen menschen als einem unchristen und gottlosen ein zeitlang vom heiligen abendmal, von gefatterschaft bei der taufe und bei der braut zustehende, oder die zu fürende in der vortrauunge abweisen, bis so lang, dass er rechte warhaftige busse thut. Diss ist die separatio oder kleiner bann, wie es die alten nennen, und geschicht ohn öffentliche ankündigunge für dem volke von der canzel, allein insonderheit, oder in gegenwart eins oder mehr prediger, oder auch dazu erfoderten christen.

such an obstinate man shall be turned away for a time, as an unchristian and ungodly man, from the holy Supper, from standing godfather at baptism and from standing by the bride or leading her at the betrothal, until he do right and true repentance. This is the *separatio* or lesser ban, as the ancients call it, and it is done without public announcement before the people from the pulpit, but privately only, or in the presence of one or more preachers, or of Christians called thereto.

### 13.16.2 The Lutheran form of excommunication: Wittenberg 1542

**Wittenberg 1542.** The Wittenberg consistory's constitution of 1542 was the first evangelical order to give a written form. No pastor may excommunicate without the consistory's judge. The consistory decides, and the pastor announces the sentence publicly in church "before the congregation, for St Paul says *congregatis omnibus vobis*". The excommunicate may come only to the sermon. He is denied the sacrament and the office of godparent, and is to be buried without song or ceremony, "in the field". A civil penalty follows: suspension from office or the council, or from his trade. **Electoral Saxony, *Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg*, 1542** (Sehling 1, p. 206):

> Forma excommunicationis. Nach dem Hans N. seiner tauf vergessen, dem teufel gefolget, und ein ehebruch (hic nominetur peccatum commissum) begangen, darumb er vielfeltig brüderlich vermanet und erinnert, davon abzustehen, und doch fursetzlich zu seiner seelen selbst verderben, darinne verharret, also, das kein rad noch hülf seiner besserung, zu hoffen ist, so thun wir genanten Hansen N. aus kraft der schlüssel, die Christus seiner kirchen gegeben, und die unbussfertigen damit zu binden, auf erden gelassen hat, in den bann, schliessen in aus der versamlung der heiligen christlichen kirchen. Verbieten im auch hiemit den brauch der christlichen sacrament, bis so lange, das er sich selbs

> bekeret und erkennet, widerumb zu dem, der dem sinkenden Petro die hand reichte, und keinen sünder wil verloren haben. Erinnere auch hierneben alle, so gehorsame glieder christlicher kirchen sich erkennen, das sie denselben Hansen N. als ein mutwilligen und unbussfertigen meiden wolten, auf das sie sich mit im nicht beschmitzen, und sich frembder sünd teilhaftig machen.

Form of excommunication. Forasmuch as Hans N. hath forgotten his baptism, followed the devil and committed adultery (here let the sin committed be named), for which he hath been many times brotherly admonished and reminded to desist therefrom, and yet wilfully, to the destruction of his own soul, continueth therein, so that no counsel nor help for his amendment is to be hoped for: therefore we put the said Hans N. into the ban, by the power of the keys which Christ hath given to his church and left on earth to bind the impenitent therewith, and shut him out of the assembly of the holy Christian church. We forbid him also hereby the use of the Christian sacraments, until he turn himself and acknowledge, and return again to him who reached his hand to the sinking Peter and will have no sinner lost. I remind also herewith all who know themselves obedient members of the Christian church, that they shun the same Hans N. as a wilful and impenitent man, lest they defile themselves with him and make themselves partakers of other men's sins.

**Reconciliation.** The order provides for reconciliation only in outline. The banned man asks grace, gives a pledge of amendment, and "is absolved by the congregation, who shall pray for him and rejoice heartily at his return" (Sehling 1, p. 207).

### 13.16.3 The full Lutheran rite: Saxe-Lauenburg 1585

**Lauenburg 1585.** Saxe-Lauenburg gives the most complete Lutheran liturgy of the ban and of public penance in Sehling. The procedure runs:

1. Private admonition by the pastor; then before two or three witnesses (churchwardens or elders).
2. Report to the superintendent, then to the consistory, which summons and hears the sinner.
3. If he remains obstinate, the consistory sentences him to the greater ban.
4. The sentence is announced the next Sunday. After the sermon the sinner is set "in the choir before all the people". The superintendent or pastor reads the sentence from the pulpit or before the altar.
5. Before communion begins, the sexton leads the excommunicate out through the people.
6. The officer forbids him weddings, feasts, taverns and "honourable company". He may work, buy and sell, and must stand in a separate place in church at every sermon, leaving before the rest of the service.

**The sentence.** The sentence closes with a prayer for the banned man. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 449):

> so haben die vorordente des kirchenrats im consistorio nach genuchsamer gepflogener handlungen, diesen menschen dahin erkennet, dass er solle in aller eurer gegenwart von der heiligen christlichen kirchen ausgeschlossen, und auch zugleich vom heiligen abendmal des waren und lebendigmachenden gegenwertigen leibs und bluts Christi als ein unwirdiger abgewiesen sein, auch bei der heiligen taufe nicht zu gefattern stehen, noch braut oder breutigam zur vertrauunge zu führen […] bis so lange, dass er an sich öffentliche busse, reue und leid, wegen seiner solcher schrecklichen sünden, neben rechter christlicher besserunge vormerken und erscheinen lasse. Doch zur predigt mag und sol er frei unvorhindert kommen […] Der allmechtige, ewiger gott, der nicht wil den todt des gottlosen, erbarme sich uber ihn durch Christum, und vorleihe ihm ware rechtschaffene busse, damit er vom künftigen zorn errettet werde. Amen. Diss heissen die alten canones den grossen bann, excommunicationem majorem. […] Nach dieser renunciation und ankündigunge des bannes sol der cüster alsbald, ehe man die communion oder etwas weiters in der kirchen anfenget, die excommunicirte person öffentlich durch das volk aus der kirchen ausweisen, und seiner wege gehen lassen.

the appointed members of the church council in the consistory, after sufficient proceedings held, have judged this man to this end: that in the presence of you all he shall be shut out of the holy Christian church, and also at the same time be turned away as one unworthy from the holy Supper of the true, life-giving and present body and blood of Christ, and also not stand godfather at holy baptism, nor lead bride or bridegroom to the betrothal […] until he let open repentance, contrition and sorrow for these his terrible sins, together with right Christian amendment, be perceived and appear in him. Yet to the sermon he may and shall come freely and unhindered […] Almighty, everlasting God, who willeth not the death of the wicked, have mercy upon him through Christ, and grant him true and right repentance, that he may be delivered from the wrath to come. Amen. This the ancient canons call the greater ban, *excommunicatio major*. […] After this renunciation and announcement of the

ban, the sexton shall forthwith, before the communion or anything further in the church be begun, lead the excommunicated person publicly out of the church through the people, and let him go his way.

**Public penance and absolution.** A sinner who repented, whether before or after the ban, was first examined before the officer, the patron, the churchwardens and other honourable men. Five questions were put: does he confess his sin, is he sorry, does he desire forgiveness and public absolution, will he amend, does he desire the Supper.

On a communion Sunday the pastor then led him before the altar, where he knelt with two friends beside him. The rite has five parts:

1. An address to the people on the binding and loosing keys, naming the sin and the penitent's repentance.
2. The Lord's Prayer.
3. Psalm 67 (*Es wolt uns Gott genädig sein*) or Psalm 51 (*Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott*).
4. The five questions, each answered "Yes".
5. The absolution and readmission.

An exhortation to the people follows: they are to thank God, pray for the penitent, forgive the offence and never cast it up to him. The penitent then communicates. **Saxe-Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 453):

> Also spreche ich hierauf, als ein vorordenter diener Jesu Christi, an gottes stat und von seinent wegen zu dir: Sei getrost mein son (oder tochter), deine sünde sind dir vorgeben. Auch nemen wir dich wiederumb an zu einem geliede des geistlichen leibs Christi, welche ist die gemeine seiner heiligen und gleubigen, von welchem leibe du dich selbst, durch deine laster, schand, sünd und ergernisse abgerissen hattest, dass du demselbigen hiemit nun widerumb einvorleibet sein sollest, im namen gottes des vaters, und des sons, und des heiligen geistes. Amen.

Therefore I say hereupon to thee, as an ordained minister of Jesus Christ, in God's stead and on his behalf: Be of good cheer, my son (or daughter), thy sins are forgiven thee. We receive thee also again to be a member of the spiritual body of Christ, which is the congregation of his saints and faithful, from which body thou hadst torn thyself by thy vices, shame, sin and offences; that thou shalt hereby now be again incorporated into the same, in the name of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. Amen.

### 13.16.4 The Mecklenburg consistory order of 1570

**The procedure.** The Mecklenburg consistory order of 1570 gives the fullest Lutheran account of the procedure (its chapter "Von der excommunication"). It begins from Matthew 18 and the rule of Deuteronomy 17, "judge with right judgement": a preacher must not only mean well but keep "a due and orderly process". The order distinguishes secret sins, which are to be rebuked in secret and never named from the pulpit, from notorious sins (*notoria facti* and *notoria iuris*). Grubenhagen in 1581 repeats much of this text word for word (§13.16.1). The steps are:

1. **Admonition.** The pastor admonishes the open sinner once or twice, alone or before two or three witnesses, warning that he will otherwise have to proceed further. A sinner who repents, even on his deathbed, is absolved without further penalty.
2. **Citation.** If he despises the admonition, the pastor reports him to the consistory, which is "the church" of Matthew 18: not "the common unlearned rabble", nor a pope or bishop, but "godly, Christian, learned, understanding men and elders" of all estates. The consistory cites him.
3. **Hearing.** He is admonished again and, if he denies the deed, convicted by two or three witnesses, or, if the case is one of doctrine, by God's word. If he then recants, he incurs no civil infamy, and the pastor announces his conversion to the church.
4. **Sentence.** If he still despises the consistory or fails to appear, he is named from the pulpit of his own parish and put in the ban by public sentence of the consistory.
5. **Execution.** The officer forbids him weddings, taverns and honourable company, but not his trade. He stands at a separate place in church at every sermon, and on communion Sundays the sexton leads him out through the people after the sermon and prayer.
6. **Absolution.** After a time of probation the pastor and officer report his amendment in writing; the consistory releases him and orders the pastor to reconcile him publicly on the next Sunday.
7. **Burial.** If he dies impenitent, the parish is not to attend his burial; he is to be buried "as a member cut off".

**The form of excommunication.** The pastor's address opens with a long exposition: God's unchangeable order is that men either obey his word or, if they sin wilfully and openly, are cursed; therefore God has commanded not only the magistrate to punish public crimes but the church to cast out those who despise its admonition. The pastor then names the sinner and the sin, rehearses the admonitions, and pronounces the sentence. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, pp. 245–246):

> Nun wisset ihr, wie in dieser kirchen N. N. bishero öffentliche falsche lehre und rotterei ausgebreitet und verteidinget (oder ein öffentlicher bekannter todschleger, ehebrecher, hurer, wucherer, trunkenboltz ist). Derhalben er auch etliche mal von mir als seinem pastor, in beisein zweier oder dreier zeugen, letzlich auch von dem erwirdigen consistorio treulich und ernstlich vermanet ist, von diesem irrtum oder laster abzustehen, und sich mit gott und der geergerten kirchen zu versönen. Dieweil er aber alle treue vermanung verachtet und in seinem muthwilligen ungehorsam, wider gottes wort und willen, trotziglich und halsstarriglich verharret, so hat das erwirdige consistorium beschlossen und mir befohlen, demselben ungehorsamen, halsstarrigen verfürer (wann er falscher lehre halben verdammt wird) oder sünder N. N., in diesem kirchspiel wonhaftig, auf heutigen sonntag in den öffentlichen bann abzukündigen und aus dieser christlichen kirchengemeinschaft aus zuschliessen. Derhalben ich, als dieser christlichen kirchen gemeiner diener und seelssorger, in dem namen unsers herrn Jesu Christi, diesen unbussfertigen offentlichen (verführer, lasterer, ehebrecher, hurer, wucherer) N. N. dem teufel itzundt ubergebe zum verderben des fleisches, auf dass sein geist selig werde am tage des herrn, wann er sich wiederum bekeren wird. Verkündige im hiemit gottes schrecklichen zorn und ungnade, und dass er von aller gemeinschaft aller heiligen im himmel und auf erden ausgeschlossen und abgeschnitten, und mit allen teufeln in der helle verflucht und ewiglich verdammt sei, so lange er in dieser unbussfertigkeit verharret. Versage ihm auch hiemit alle kirchenrecht und aller heiligen sacrament gemeinschaft, ausgenommen die anhörung der predigt. Bitte auch und vermane alle christen, dass sie mit diesem N. N. forthin nichts zu schaffen haben, und sich seiner gemeinschaft ganz entschlahen, nicht mit ime essen oder drinken, ihn nicht zu gevattern bitten, zu keiner hochzeit oder anderer ehrliche gesellschaft laden, auch auf der strassen oder sonst nicht grüssen, damit er beschemet und gedemütiget werde und seine sünde desto ehr bekenne und sich zu gott bekehre und mit der christlichen kirchen, die er mit seinem ungehorsam zum höchsten beleidiget und geergert hat, versüne etc.

Now ye know how in this church N. N. hath hitherto spread abroad and defended public false doctrine and faction (or is an open, known manslayer, adulterer, whoremonger, usurer, drunkard). For which cause he hath been several times faithfully and earnestly admonished by me as his pastor, in the presence of two or three witnesses, and lastly also by the reverend consistory, to desist from this error or vice and to be reconciled with God and the offended church. But since he hath despised all faithful admonition and continueth defiantly and obstinately in his wilful disobedience against God's word and will, the reverend consistory hath resolved and commanded me to proclaim the same disobedient, obstinate seducer (when he is condemned for false doctrine) or sinner N. N., dwelling in this parish, on this present Sunday into the public ban, and to shut him out of this Christian fellowship of the church. Therefore I, as the common minister and pastor of this Christian church, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, do now deliver this impenitent, public (seducer, blasphemer, adulterer, whoremonger, usurer) N. N. unto the devil for the destruction of the flesh, that his spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord, when he shall turn again. I declare unto him herewith God's terrible wrath and displeasure, and that he is shut out and cut off from all fellowship of all saints in heaven and on earth, and cursed and eternally damned with all devils in hell, so long as he continueth in this impenitence. I deny him also herewith all rights of the church and the fellowship of all holy sacraments, save the hearing of the sermon. I beseech and exhort also all Christians that they have nothing more to do with this N. N., and withdraw themselves wholly from his company; not eat or drink with him, not ask him to stand godfather, not bid him to any wedding or other honourable company, nor greet him in the street or elsewhere; that he may be ashamed and humbled, and the sooner confess his sin and turn to God, and be reconciled with the Christian church, which he hath offended and scandalized in the highest degree by his disobedience, etc.

**The absolution from the ban.** On the Sunday appointed the pastor announces the consistory's release and bids the people pray. The excommunicate kneels before the congregation; the pastor says the public confession and the absolution "as is customary in our churches", and the act ends with the usual hymn. **Mecklenburg, *Consistorialordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 246):

> Ihr geliebten in Christo, nachdem bis anher dieser N. ein zeitlang von wegen seiner misshandlung und verstockung aus der heiligen christlichen kirchen, als ein unnutz glied, abgesondert, und von dem heiligen sacrament des nachtmals, auch andern ehrlichen kirchenversammlungen ausgeschlossen gewesen, und aber sich seither aus gottes gnaden in dieser straf gehorsamlich, geduldig und christlich gehalten, auch versprochen, er wolle forthin durch gottes gnade ein christlich unergerlich leben führen. So haben die verordenten des consistorii nach empfangenen bericht und eingenommener kundschaft erkennet, dass der bemeldte N. seiner kirchenstraf zu diesemmal, vergangener sachen halben erledigt und

> wiederum zu der empfahung des heiligen sacraments des abendmals, auch andern ehrlichen kirchenversammlungen zugelassen werde. Und sollet ir alle hierauf verwarnet sein, fleissig zu bitten, dass der allmechtige barmherzige gott diesem N. und uns allen unsere sünde durch Jesum Christum gnediglich vergeben, und mit dem heiligen geist begnaden wolle, dass wir bis in unsern tod ein züchtig, ehrlich leben führen, durch Jesum Christum, unsern herrn. Darauf soll der pfarrherr den excommunicirten, so vor angesicht der gemeine nieder gekniet, die öffentliche beichte und alsbalt auch die absolution, wie die in unsern kirchen ublich, fürsprechen und den acctum ecclesiae mit dem gewöhnlichen gesange beschliessen.

Dearly beloved in Christ, forasmuch as this N. hath hitherto for a time been separated, as an unprofitable member, from the holy Christian church because of his misdeed and obstinacy, and shut out from the holy sacrament of the Supper and from other honourable assemblies of the church; and hath since, by God's grace, behaved himself obediently, patiently and Christianly under this punishment, and hath also promised that he will henceforth by God's grace lead a Christian life without offence: therefore the appointed members of the consistory, after report received and inquiry made, have judged that the said N. is released from his church punishment for this time, as touching things past, and admitted again to the receiving of the holy sacrament of the Supper and to other honourable assemblies of the church. And ye shall all be warned hereupon diligently to pray that the almighty, merciful God will graciously forgive this N. and us all our sins through Jesus Christ, and endue us with the Holy Ghost, that we may lead a chaste and honourable life unto our death, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Thereupon the pastor shall say before the excommunicate, who kneeleth before the face of the congregation, the public confession and forthwith the absolution as is customary in our churches, and shall close the act of the church with the usual hymn.

#### 13.16.5 Mansfeld 1580: discipline, the ban and open penance

**The ban.** The Mansfeld agenda of 1580 (chapter 19) records the agreement of the Mansfeld synod of 1562 to keep the discipline "which hath been customary in the churches of this county now many years". The ban is "the public separation from the Christian congregation and delivering to Satan of the impenitent and persistent sinners". As in Saxony and Mecklenburg, no pastor may proceed of himself: the consistory weighs the case, and if it resolves on the ban it commits the pastor of the parish and gives him a written form (*notel*) from which he may not depart or mix in his own feelings (Sehling 2, p. 241). The pronouncement follows Paul's words in 1 Corinthians 5.

**Open penance without the ban.** Chapter 19 defends the Mansfeld practice of requiring open penance not only from the excommunicate but from every notorious sinner, against those who called it defamation. Such sinners "are de facto in the ban, though the church hath not yet shut them out", and what was sinned against all must be made good before all. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, pp. 241–242):

> Man sol aber auch das wissen, das gott in seiner schrift zwischen den offentlich verbanneten und anderen beharlichen und ergerlichen sündern keinen unterscheid machet, denn solche sind de facto im bann, ob sie schon die kirche noch nicht hat ausgeschlossen [...] Wenn nu aber eine ganze kirche und gemeine beleidiget und geergert ist durch offentliche sünde und laster, wie kan denn die abbittung und versöhnung gegen dieselbe anders denn offentlichen geschehen, was gegen allen offentlich gesündiget worden, das muss je gegen allen offentlich abgetragen werden

But this also is to be known, that God in his Scripture maketh no difference between those publicly banned and other persistent and offensive sinners; for such are de facto in the ban, though the church hath not yet shut them out [...] But now when a whole church and congregation is offended and scandalized by public sin and vice, how then can the begging of pardon and the reconciliation toward it be done otherwise than publicly? What hath been sinned publicly against all must surely be made good publicly toward all.

**The rite of open penance.** Chapter 20 gives the "process how those who do open penance are received again into the fellowship of the church":

1. A time of probation, to see that the repentance is earnest.
2. A day is appointed. After the sermon the pastor names from the pulpit, in the penitent's presence, his fall and sin, his conversion and his begging pardon for the offence.
3. The penitent kneels or stands before the altar, and the minister asks him publicly three questions: whether he confesses that he has sinned openly, angered God and offended many Christians; whether he is heartily sorry and desires to be reconciled by open penance with God and the offended congregation; whether he means by God's help to amend, and truly believes that for Christ's sake his sins are forgiven him by the holy absolution. He answers "Yes".

4. The public absolution, below.
5. An exhortation to the people to recognize their own weakness, "for whoso standeth, let him take heed lest he fall" (1 Corinthians 10:12).

**Mansfeld, *Kirchen-Agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, pp. 242–243):

> Absolutio. Gott der vater unsers herrn Jesu Christi, der dich zuerkentnis deiner sünden bracht hat, und geschworen: Als war ich lebe, ich wil nicht den tod des Sünders, sondern das er sich bekere und lebe, der hat dir umb seines lieben sons willen alle deine sünde verziehen. Und ich, als ein unwirdiger diener, spreche dich an seiner stat, und in seinem namen, auch offentlich, und für dieser gemeine allhie von denselben los, und neme dich auf zu dieser seiner heiligen kirchen gemeinschaft, daraus du gefallen warest. Auf das du von im mit seinem heiligen geist regieret werdest, und mit uns andren seines heiligen sacraments nützlich und wirdiglich, zu sterkung deines glaubens und des lebens besserung brauchen, und ewig selig werden mögest. Im namen gottes des vaters, und des sons, und des heiligen geistes, † Amen.

Absolution. God the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who hath brought thee to the knowledge of thy sins, and hath sworn: As I live, I will not the death of the sinner, but that he turn and live; he hath forgiven thee all thy sins for his dear Son's sake. And I, as an unworthy minister, in his stead and in his name, do also publicly and before this congregation here loose thee from the same, and receive thee into the fellowship of this his holy church, out of which thou hadst fallen; that thou mayest be governed by him with his Holy Spirit, and use with us others his holy sacrament profitably and worthily, to the strengthening of thy faith and the amendment of life, and be saved for ever. In the name of God the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost. † Amen.

### 13.16.6 Grubenhagen 1581: the form of absolution from the ban

**Grubenhagen 1581.** Grubenhagen took over the Mecklenburg form of excommunication (§13.16.4) and added its own "form of the absolution from the ban and the public receiving of the penitent sinner into the congregation of God". The penitent has given signs of repentance on three appointed Sundays. The pastor addresses the people on God's mercy to fallen sinners (Adam and Eve, Aaron, David, Manasseh, the sinful woman, the thief on the cross), announces the consistory's mandate, puts three questions, and absolves with the formula of John 20:23. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1058):

> Derwegen frage ich dich, N.N., ob du bekennest, das du mit deinem fall Gott erzörnet, viel Christen betrübet und diese kirche und gemeine geergert hast? Antwort: Ja. Ich frage dich ferner, ob du von herzen aus dem bann begerest, mit Gott und dieser kirchen, auch jederman, versöhnet zu sein, und bittest diese christliche gemeine, das sie dir umb Gottes willen verzeihen wolte, das du sie mit deinem fall betrübet und mit deinem halstarrigen ungehorsam geergert hast? Antwort: Ja. Ich frage dich zum dritten, ob du auch gleubest dem heiligen evangelio, das dir Gott umb seines Sones und desselben theuren verdienstes willen alle deine sünde vergeben wil, und das meine vergebung Gottes vergebung sey, gedenkest auch, forthin in solchem glauben christlich zu wandeln, erbarlich zu leben und an diese veterliche züchtigung dein leben lang zu gedenken und Gott zu bitten, das du nimmermehr in sicherheit fallest? Antwort: Ja. […] Und ich anstat und [auf] befehl meines Herrn Jhesu Christi vermöge seiner eigenen, warhaftigen, ewigen, unwandelbaren wort, aus seinem göttlichen herzen und munde gesprochen, da er gesaget hat: Welchen ihr die sünde erlasset, denen sind sie erlassen, vergebe dir, N. N., hiermit alle deine sünde und verkündige dir Gottes gnad, freud, trost und ewiges leben, und das du widerumb zur gemeinschaft der christlichen kirchen aufgenommen bist im namen des Vaters, Sons und heiligen Geistes. Amen. Was nu auf erden gelöset ist, das soll auch im himmel loß sein, spricht Christus.

Therefore I ask thee, N. N., whether thou confessest that by thy fall thou hast angered God, grieved many Christians and offended this church and congregation? Answer: Yea. I ask thee further whether thou desirest from thy heart to be loosed from the ban and reconciled with God and this church, and with every man, and beseechest this Christian congregation that it would forgive thee for God's sake that thou hast grieved it by thy fall and offended it by thy obstinate disobedience? Answer: Yea. I ask thee thirdly whether thou believest also the holy gospel, that God will forgive thee all thy sins for the sake of his Son and his precious merit, and that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness; and whether thou purposest henceforth to walk Christianly in such faith, to live honestly, and to remember this fatherly chastisement all thy life long, and to pray God that thou never fall into security? Answer: Yea. […] And I, in the stead and by the command of my Lord Jesus Christ, by virtue of his own true, eternal, unchangeable word, spoken out of his divine heart and mouth, when he said, Whose sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them, do forgive thee, N. N., herewith all thy sins, and proclaim unto thee God's grace, joy, comfort and eternal life, and that thou art received again into the fellowship of the Christian church; in the name of the Father, Son and Holy Ghost. Amen. What now is loosed on earth shall be loosed also in heaven, saith Christ.

The pastor then warns the people, "Let him that standeth take heed lest he fall", and forbids them to cast up the fall to the penitent or to think him of ill civil repute (*infamia*).

### 13.16.7 The Reformed form: Micron's London order

**Micron's order** (Reformed). The fullest Reformed rite is that of the Dutch stranger church in London, in Marten Micron's *Ordinancien* of 1554. Sehling prints it in the German translation used in East Frisia (1565). The procedure runs:

1. Private, then public admonition.
2. The sinner's name is announced twice to the congregation as a despiser of admonition.
3. A day is set, and anyone with objections from God's word has a week to bring them to the ministers and elders.
4. On the day, the morning sermon is shortened and the minister expounds the nature and end of the ban:
    - it is Christ's ordinance;
    - it punishes contempt of admonition rather than the sin itself;
    - the papal ban is void;
    - the power lies with the whole congregation, not with the ministers alone;
    - it is not contrary to love.
5. All the ministers stand before the congregation. The minister rehearses the case and asks his colleagues whether it is so; they answer "Yes".
6. All kneel for a prayer that God would break "the stony heart of our brother N.", followed by the Lord's Prayer.
7. If the sinner comes forward and shows true repentance, public penance replaces the ban. If not, the minister pronounces the excommunication in the form of a prayer to Christ.
8. The congregation is instructed how to treat him: as a heathen and publican, avoiding his company except in civil matters, yet seeking his amendment like a physician. Psalm 101 is sung.

**The prayer of excision. Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 652):

> so folgen wir, o Herr Jesu Christe, deinem heiligen gebot und schneiden ihn als ein faul glied offentlich ab von dem heiligen leib deiner gemeine, und das mit grosser trübnuß unserer herzen und mitleiden seiner verderbnuß. Wir binden hie auf erden seine sünden und sind auß deinem wort versichert, daß sie auch bey dir im himmel gebunden sind. Wir werfen ihn hie auß deinem seligen reich (auf daß er bey allen glaubigen für ein heid und zölner geachtet werde) und geben ihn durch dein gebot dem teufel zur verderbung seines fleisches, auf daß sein geist selig werde, durch deinen heihgen namen, der du lebest und regierest mit dem Vater und dem heiligen Geist, ein einiger und ewiger Gott, gepriesen in ewigkeit. Amen.

we follow, O Lord Jesus Christ, thy holy commandment, and cut him off publicly as a rotten member from the holy body of thy congregation, and that with great sorrow of our hearts and compassion for his destruction. We bind here on earth his sins, and are assured out of thy word that they are bound also with thee in heaven. We cast him here out of thy blessed kingdom (that he may be accounted of all the faithful as a heathen and a publican), and give him by thy commandment to the devil for the destruction of his flesh, that his spirit may be saved; through thy holy name, who livest and reignest with the Father and the Holy Ghost, one only and eternal God, blessed for ever. Amen.

**Readmission.** The return of the excommunicate (chapter 26) follows the same pattern in reverse:

1. The elders visit him and examine his repentance.
2. A day is announced a week ahead, so that the congregation may "receive with joyful heart" the one it had cut off with sorrow.
3. On the day the ministers and elders stand beside him. The minister proves from Scripture that the fallen obtain forgiveness, and that "public offences require public reconciliation".
4. A prayer is said in which the whole congregation joins its sins to his.
5. He confesses and is received again (Sehling 7/1, pp. 653–655).

### 13.16.8 Other orders

The same pattern, with local variations, appears in:

- **Hesse** (Moderate Reformed). The *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung* of 1539 introduced elders, and its ban was pronounced before pastor and elders. The Hesse order of 1566 required the banned sinner to do penance "before the whole congregation which he had offended" (Sehling 8, p. 212).
- **The Palatinate 1563** (Reformed). Exclusion from the sacraments was to lie "not in the power of one or several ministers or other persons, but with a whole Christian congregation". Elders admonish three times and then separate the offender by forbidding the sacraments (Sehling 14, p. 388). Later Palatine ordinances add chapters *De excommunicatione* and *De receptione* (Sehling 14, pp. 423–424).
- **Town of Brandenburg 1542.** A dissenting voice: the sacrament was to be refused to no one, since one whom God's word does not move will not be moved by exclusion; grave crimes belong to the civil power (Sehling 3, p. 255).
- **Couples who anticipated marriage.** The commonest public penance in practice was that of a couple who had lain together before their wedding. Nassau-Weilburg in 1609 required such a couple to do "public church penance" before they could be blessed, unless they had already been betrothed, in which case the fault was rebuked at the wedding itself; Hohenlohe in 1572 had both "set forth to public church penance and begging of pardon" (Sehling 10, p. 353; 15, p. 177).
- **Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1591 and Solms** (Reformed). Counts with Reformed leanings imposed "Christian ban and exclusion from the congregation" through a presbytery, with the magistrate's help (Sehling 10, pp. 596, 599; 9, p. 328).

**Burial of the excommunicate.** Burial followed the ban. Wittenberg 1542 ordered that the excommunicate be buried "not with song or ceremonies, nor in the common churchyard of the Christians, but in the field" (Sehling 1, p. 206).

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## 13.17 Private confession and absolution

**Auricular confession abolished, private absolution kept.** Every evangelical order abolished the medieval sacrament of penance as a duty to enumerate all mortal sins to a priest, with satisfaction imposed. The Pomesanian articles of 1524 already ended confession "by which one would be bound to name all sins" (Sehling 4, p. 29). But the Lutheran orders kept, and generally required, private confession and absolution before communion. They kept it for three reasons:

- the absolution is the gospel spoken to the single person, "as if God by a voice from heaven promised thee grace";
- the pastor could examine those coming to the Supper in the catechism;
- the troubled conscience could be comforted.

Many Upper German orders replaced it with an examination of communicants (§13.17.4). The private and public forms of absolution after open sin and the ban are in §13.16.

### 13.17.1 The Lutheran position

**Dietrich 1545: no enumeration, no compulsion.** Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg agenda states the principle: the papal auricular confession is not commanded by God, and no minister may refuse absolution until the sins have been counted. It is enough that the person confesses himself a sinner and desires grace (Sehling 11, p. 528).

**Saxony 1580: private absolution required before communion.** The Saxon order of 1580 treats private absolution as a free thing, not a papal compulsion, yet requires everyone to present himself to his pastor and seek it before communion, "for the sake of Christian discipline and specially for the sake of the ignorant". **Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 427):

> VII. Von der rechten christlichen beicht und privat absolution. Nach dem der pfarrer und kirchendiener das volk gründlich aus gottes wort unterrichtet, was der unterscheid zwischen der papistischen ohrenbeicht, da die leut gemartert und gezwungen alle sünde, das unmüglich ist Psalm 19. zu erzelen, und der warhaftigen christlichen beicht sei, darinnen die jugend zu bekentnis und rechenschaft ihres glaubens angehalten, jeder seines berufs in sonderheit erinnert, fürnemlich aber die kleinmütigen angefochtene gewissen aus gottes wort in iren schweren besondern anliegen getröstet werden, sollen sie die ganze gemeine fleissig zu solcher vermanen, und öffentlich anzeigen, das man niemand zum hochwirdigen sacrament des leibes und bluts des herrn Christi zulassen werde, er habe denn zuvor sich bei seinen ordentlichen pastorn angezeigt, und die privat absolution gesucht.

VII. Of right Christian confession and private absolution. After the pastor and ministers of the church have thoroughly taught the people out of God's word what is the difference between the papistical ear-confession, wherein people were tormented and forced to recount all their sins, which is impossible (Psalm 19), and the true Christian confession, wherein the youth are held to

confession and account of their faith, every one is admonished of his calling in particular, but chiefly the faint-hearted, tempted consciences are comforted out of God's word in their heavy particular troubles: they shall diligently exhort the whole congregation thereto, and declare publicly that none shall be admitted to the most worthy sacrament of the body and blood of the Lord Christ unless he have first presented himself to his ordinary pastor and sought the private absolution.

#### 13.17.2 The form of confession: Luther's catechism

**The catechism form.** The common form was the one Luther added to the Small Catechism, "How the simple shall be taught to confess". Many orders print it; the Palatinate under Ottheinrich (1556) gives it entire. The rite is:

1. The penitent: "Worthy, dear sir, I pray you hear my confession and pronounce forgiveness to me for God's sake."
2. A general confession before God of all sins, and a particular confession before the confessor of the sins one knows and feels, according to one's station under the Ten Commandments (a servant's, a master's or mistress's). One who knows of no particular sin is not to invent any, but to take the forgiveness on the general confession.
3. "God be merciful to thee and strengthen thy faith."
4. "Believest thou that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness?" "Yea, dear sir."
5. The absolution: "As thou believest, so be it unto thee", and the dismissal.

**Palatinate, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556** (Sehling 14, p. 140):

> Darauf sol der beichtiger sagen: Gott sey dir gnedig und stercke deinen glauben, Amen. Sprich: Glaubstu auch, daß meine vergebung Gottes vergebung sey? Ja, lieber herr. Darauf spreche er: Wie du glaubst, so geschehe dir. Und ich auß befehl unsers herrn Jhesu Christi vergeb dir deine sünde im namen des vaters und des sohns und des heiligen geists, Amen. Gehe hin im friede. Welche aber grosse beschwerung des gewissens haben oder betrübt und angefochten sind, die wird ein beichtiger wol wissen, mit mehr sprüchen zu trösten und zu glauben raitzen.

Thereupon shall the confessor say: God be merciful unto thee and strengthen thy faith. Amen. Say: Believest thou also that my forgiveness is God's forgiveness? Yea, dear sir. Thereupon let him say: As thou believest, so be it unto thee. And I, by the command of our Lord Jesus Christ, forgive thee thy sins, in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Amen. Go in peace. But those who have great burden of conscience, or are grieved and tempted, the confessor will well know how to comfort with more sayings and to stir to faith.

The same form stands in the Lippe order of 1566, where the five catechism questions on the Supper precede it (Sehling 21, p. 379).

#### 13.17.3 The form of absolution: Brandenburg 1540

**Brandenburg 1540.** Electoral Brandenburg gives a pastoral form in two parts, with the laying on of hands:

- **For the careless.** The confessor first asks whether the penitent knows the Ten Commandments. If not, he shows him that this is "the greatest sin a man may commit", to ask nothing after God, and bids him learn God's word.
- **For the contrite.** To one who confesses himself a poor sinner he says that this knowledge of sin is itself a work of the Holy Ghost, and explains that the absolution gives him in person the grace preached to all the world: "this word of absolution … thou shalt regard as if God by a voice from heaven promised thee grace and forgiveness of thy sins". Then he lays his hands on him and absolves.

**Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, pp. 62–63):

> Nach solcher unterricht, so er die absolution begeret, so sprech er mit auflegung der hende zu im wie folget: Form der absolution. Der allmechtig gott und vater unsers herrn Jesu Christ wil dir gnedig und barmherzig sein, und wil dir alle deine sunde vergeben um des willen, das sein lieber son Jesus Christus dafur gelitten hat und gestorben ist und im namen desselbigen unsers herrn Jesu Christi, auf seinen befelch und in kraft seiner wort, da er sagt: welchen ir die sunde erlasset, den sind sie erlassen etc., spreche ich dich aller deiner sunden frei, ledig und los, das sie dir alzumal, sollen vergeben sein, so reichlich und volkomen, als Jesus Christus dasselbige durch sein leiden und sterben verdienet und durchs evangelium in alle welt zu predigen befohlen und dieser tröstlichen zusage, die ich dir itzt im namen des herrn Christi gethan, der wollest dich tröstlich annemen, dein gewissen darauf zufrieden stellen und festiglich glauben, deine sund sind dir gewislich vergeben. Im namen des vaters und des sons und des heiligen geists. Gehe hin im friede.

After such instruction, if he desireth the absolution, let him speak to him with laying on of hands as followeth: Form of absolution. The almighty God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ will be gracious and merciful unto thee, and will forgive thee all thy sins, for this cause, that his dear Son Jesus Christ hath suffered and died for them; and in the name of the same our Lord Jesus Christ, at his command and in the power of his word, where he saith, Whose sins ye remit, they are remitted unto them, etc., I pronounce thee free, quit and loosed of all thy sins, that they shall be all forgiven thee, as richly and completely as Jesus Christ hath merited the same by his suffering and death and commanded it to be preached through the gospel in all the world. And this comfortable promise, which I have now made thee in the name of the Lord Christ, receive thou with comfort, set thy conscience at rest thereupon, and believe firmly that thy sins are surely forgiven thee. In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Ghost. Go in peace.

**Refusal.** The same order tells pastors to refuse absolution and the Sacrament to heretics, blasphemers, open sinners and those who will not learn the commandments, the creed and the Lord's Prayer, until they show signs of amendment, and then to absolve and readmit them (Sehling 3, p. 63). The Saxon form for the sick of 1539 used the same private absolution, ending "Zeuch hin im friede" (§13.8.3).

#### 13.17.4 Without private confession: the examination of communicants

**Upper German orders.** Several south-western cities kept no private confession. In its place came the examination of communicants (*Verhör*), deliberately designed so that it could not be mistaken for auricular confession. Reutlingen, about 1531, had the children brought by father or mother, girls with the mother and boys with the father, to give account of their faith openly in church, "that it may not be suspected for a papistical ear-confession and snare of consciences" (Sehling 17/2, pp. 43–44).

**Confession money abolished.** The confession penny (*Beichtgeld*, *Beichtpfennig*) went with the old penance. Baden in 1533 relieved the people of stole fees "for confession, for the sacrament of the altar, for the holy anointing", and Hohenlohe in 1588 forbade pastors to take confession pennies (Sehling 16, p. 502; 15, p. 549).

The examination before first communion is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.2, and general confession at the Mass in Chapter 3, §3.4.6.

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## 13.18 Processions

**What went and what stayed.** The medieval church walked in procession constantly: round the church with holy water every Sunday, through the fields on the Rogation days and St Mark's day, with palms and the Palm-Sunday ass, with the sacrament on Corpus Christi, with relics, banners and crosses on patronal feasts and against hail and plague. The evangelical orders abolished the processions that carried the sacrament, relics or images or that invoked the saints, and almost all of the field processions. What stayed were processions that served the Word, prayer or common order:

- the funeral procession with hymns (§13.9);
- the bride's procession to church (*Kirchgang*, §13.7);
- the schoolboys' and townspeople's festal processions at Hof (§13.14.3);
- in Electoral Brandenburg and Mulhouse (Reformed), the Sunday procession, Palm Sunday and the Rogation prayers in a purified form.

Who walked in these processions and what was carried in them is set out in §13.18.4.

The fate of Corpus Christi, the Rogation days and the *Hagelfeier* in the calendar is treated in Chapter 12 §§12.8.9 and 12.12.5.

#### 13.18.1 Abolished

**Pfalz-Neuburg 1543.** The Pfalz-Neuburg order, following Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533, put the abolition of processions at the head of its list of abolished blessings (§13.15.1). **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 96):

> Darnach sollen auch unterwegen bleiben alle procession und umbgenge umb die kirchen mit dem weichwasser und mit dem heiligen sacrament in der monstranzen.

Thereafter also all processions and goings about the church with the holy water and with the holy sacrament in the monstrance shall be left off.

Brandenburg-Nürnberg in 1533 likewise counted "going with the crosses" and "carrying about the holy sacrament" among the ceremonies done away (Sehling 11, pp. 203–204). A Feuchtwangen text of 1563 named the processions "with statues, banners, wooden crosses", the "impious pomp of the feast of Corpus Christi" and the carrying about of the Eucharist among the papal ceremonies (Sehling 11, p. 406). The Pomesanian articles of 1524 ended processions "as having no ground in God's word" (Sehling 4, p. 29).

#### 13.18.2 Kept and purified: Electoral Brandenburg 1540

**Brandenburg 1540.** Joachim II's order is the great exception. It kept the Sunday procession round the church without holy water (§13.15.2), the Palm Sunday procession without the blessing of the palms, and the Rogation processions "before the church", purged of the invocation of saints; and it added a weekly German litany. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 88):

> Den palmentag sol man halten mit der procession und gesengen wie von alters, doch das die weihung der palmen vorbleibe […] Von der creuzwochen. Als auch hergekomen, das am tage Marci und die drei folgende tage nach dem sontage Vocem Jocunditatis und an etlichen sonderlichen ortern, auf ander mehr gezeiten, gemeine gebet fur der kirchen und anderer notturft gehalten, so denn der heilig Sant Paul 1. Timot. 2. getreulich vermanet, für die öbrigkeit und sonst fleissig zu bitten, so ist auch darauf unser gemtüt, das solchs also bleibe, als es jeders orts von alters christlich hergebracht und desselben gelegenheit geben wil, doch in allweg das reine und christliche gesenge, gebet und collecten darzu gebraucht werden […] Es sollen auch die misbreuch, so etwan bei solchen processionen gewesen, mit anrufung der heiligen abthan werden und alle gebet und gesenge dahin gerichtet werden, das wir all unser not und anligen bei niemand anders denn dem herrn Christo suchen und von im hülf bitten sollen.

Palm Sunday shall be kept with the procession and chants as of old, yet so that the hallowing of the palms be left off […] Of Rogation week. Whereas it hath also come down that on St Mark's day and the three days following the Sunday *Vocem jucunditatis*, and in some particular places at other times also, common prayers have been held for the church and other necessities, and holy St Paul, 1 Timothy 2, faithfully exhorteth us to pray diligently for the magistrates and others, it is also our mind that this so remain, as it hath come down from of old in Christian wise in every place and as the occasion of each will give, yet in all ways that pure and Christian chants, prayers and collects be used thereto […] Also the abuses that have been at such processions, with the invocation of the saints, shall be done away, and all prayers and chants directed to this end, that we seek all our need and concern from none other but the Lord Christ and ask help of him.

**Mulhouse 1524** (Reformed). Mulhouse kept the Rogation processions on St George's and St Mark's days and the three Rogation days, but only within the parish church of St Stephen, "since the common prayer of Christians together is most pleasing to God", and without "running to particular saints or churches" (Sehling 20/2, p. 195).

#### 13.18.3 Processions that remained

**Funerals, weddings, festivals.** The common evangelical processions were those of the life of the parish:

- **Funerals.** The body was fetched from the house and carried to the churchyard with the schoolboys singing, the minister and the people following (§§13.9.2–13.9.3).
- **Weddings.** The bride's *Kirchgang* with her maidens and the bridegroom's company to the church door or altar (§13.7); withheld from the bride who had fallen (§13.7.6) and from the divorced who remarried (§13.7.10).
- **Festivals.** At Hof the whole town walked in procession to the church dedication festival and to the school festival on Whit Monday, with wreathed schoolboys and hymns (§13.14.3).

#### 13.18.4 Who walked and what was carried

**The answer in brief.** Where the orders describe a procession, the people in it are almost always the same four groups, in this order:

1. **the cross**, carried by a schoolboy or by the sexton;
2. **the schoolboys** with their schoolmaster or cantor, singing;

3. **the clergy**: the pastor (the "priest" or celebrant, who was also the preacher) and his chaplains or deacons, in surplices;
4. **the people**: men first, then maidens, then women; at a funeral, the mourners after the coffin.

No evangelical order names any of the following in a procession:

- **Persons.** A bishop or superintendent as such (at Hof the clergy walk as a body); a deacon or subdeacon with a distinct liturgical role; any of the minor orders.
- **Objects.** A thurible, incense boat, torches, candle-snuffer, crosier, mitre, canopy, banner, Gospel book, Bible or hymnal.

The only things carried in the evangelical processions are these:

- **the cross or crucifix**;
- **lights**, tolerated at Brandenburg funerals "with measure", and borne before the sacrament in Baden 1533;
- **the sacramental vessels** taken to the sick (§13.8.2);
- **the corpse** on its bier.

What the medieval processions had carried was abolished: banners, wooden crosses, statues, the Palm-Sunday ass, the Easter image, the monstrance, relics and holy water. The ministers of the minor orders analysed in Chapter 16 §16.4 had no place in any procession; their work was done by schoolboys and the sexton.

**The order of march: Stendal 1541.** The fullest description is the visitors' order for the Rogation procession at Stendal. The priests, schoolboys and people of each parish gather at seven in the morning, sing *Exurge Domine*, and go in order to the Church of Our Lady, singing *Media vita* and then *Mitten wir im Leben sind*. There a Mass or the office is sung and a sermon on prayer is preached. **Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 314):

> also das uf den Montag in der kreuzwochen die priester, schuler und das volk, so in jede pfarkirche bei euch gehort, sollen des morgens um VII hora in derselben pfarkirche zusammen kommen und am ersten vor der procession singen das Antiphon exurge domine und hernach die processionen ordentlich halten, als am ersten ein kreuz vorher tragen, dornach die schuler, folgend die priester und hernach die man, junkfrauen und frauen und sollen die schuler und priester in der procession singen das Antiphon media vita lateinisch, wan das aus ist, alsdan den deutschen gesang: „Mitten wir im leben sein,"

[…] so that on the Monday in Rogation week the priests, scholars and people belonging to each parish church among you shall come together in the same parish church at seven o'clock in the morning, and first, before the procession, sing the antiphon *Exurge Domine*, and afterward hold the processions in order: as, first, to carry a cross before, thereafter the scholars, following them the priests, and after them the men, maidens and women; and the scholars and priests shall sing in the procession the antiphon *Media vita* in Latin, and when that is ended, then the German hymn *Mitten wir im Leben sind* […]

**Funerals: cross, school, clergy, coffin.** The funeral procession is the one procession found in nearly every Lutheran order (§13.9). Its order matches Stendal's. Electoral Brandenburg puts the cross first, then the schoolboys and then the priests, and leaves the old custom of carrying lights. **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 81):

> in deductione funeris sol man ein creuz furtragen, darauf die schüler und denn die priester folgen. Bei etlichen alten ists auch gebreuchlich gewesen, licht mit zu tragen, und do solchs in ubung were, mag es mit mass auch bleiben, und so man die leiche tregt, mag man singen, media vita und die drei deutsche vers, mitten wir im leben sind, und so der weg zu lang, das deudsche deprofundis, aus tiefer not, oder sonst das responsorium libera me domine.

In the leading forth of the body a cross shall be carried before, whereupon the scholars and then the priests follow. With some of old it hath also been customary to carry lights withal, and where that is in use, it may also remain with measure; and while the body is carried, they may sing *Media vita* and the three German verses *Mitten wir im Leben sind*, and if the way be too long, the German *De profundis*, *Aus tiefer Not*, or else the responsory *Libera me, Domine*.

In Waldeck the sexton carries the cross, and the schoolboys, schoolmaster and pastor walk before the coffin. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 256):

> Darnach gehet der Priester vor des verstorbenen hauß, und soll der Custer oder Opfferman mit eynem Creutz unnd nehest ime die Schuler sampt dem Schulmeyster und Pastor vor der Leich hergehen Unnd, an welchen ortten Schuler

> sein, eyn Christlich gesenge, Als mit namen: Si bona suscepimus, Item: Auß tieffer not, Oder: Erbarm dich mein, O Herre Gott, auff dem wege singen.

Thereafter the priest goeth before the house of the departed, and the sexton or *Opfermann* shall go with a cross, and next to him the scholars together with the schoolmaster and pastor, before the corpse; and in places where there are scholars, they shall sing a Christian hymn on the way, as by name: *Si bona suscepimus*; item, *Aus tiefer Not*; or, *Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott*.

The same pattern recurs elsewhere:

- **Who carries the cross.** In Anhalt's order of the German hymns (before 1551) "a boy from the school shall carry a cross on a staff before the procession" (Sehling 2, p. 555); at Prenzlau "a cross shall be carried before by the scholars, which the body followeth with the school" (Sehling 3, p. 261).
- **The pastor fetches the dead.** At Gottleuba the dead are fetched "with the school", and "a cross is carried before the corpse" (Sehling 1, p. 568). A Henneberg pastor reports, "I fetch the body with the sexton, scholars and cross" (Sehling 2, p. 342).
- **The crucifix.** Freiberg in 1538 required "a crucifix to be carried before at every burial, specially in honour of the high and comfortable article of the resurrection of the dead" (Sehling 1, p. 468). Wolfstein in 1574 allowed it "as a testimony on whom the Christians die, namely on the crucified Lord Jesus Christ", but called lights for the dead useless (Sehling 13, p. 586). Schwäbisch Hall allowed the cross "significatively, not effectively" (Sehling 17/1, p. 173).
- **Refused.** The impenitent were buried without bells, hymns, "cross-bearing, accompaniment or processions" (Schönburg 1542, Sehling 2, p. 175; §13.9.4).

**What the clergy wore.** The surplice (*Chorrock*) was the processional vestment. The visitors at Perleberg in 1581 required the pastor, chaplains and sexton to wear it at funerals "that they be not taken for craftsmen". **Perleberg, *Visitations-Abschied*, 1581** (Sehling 3, p. 256):

> Und weil der seelsorger amt erfordert und von alters christlich herbracht, die toten mit gewenlichen christlichen gesengen zur erden zu bestettigen, so sollen demnach der pfarrer, caplene und kuster in begleitunge der toten ire chorrocke antragen, auf das sie nicht vor handwerker angesehen werden

And forasmuch as the office of the curates of souls requireth, and it hath come down in Christian wise from of old, to commit the dead to the earth with customary Christian hymns, the pastor, chaplains and sexton shall therefore put on their surplices in accompanying the dead, that they be not taken for craftsmen [...]

The Upper German orders went the other way. Amberg in 1555 left it free whether the ministers wore surplices "over the street", but the one who gave the exhortation was to wear his in church (Sehling 13, p. 294). Hohenlohe in 1590 told its pastors to accompany the dead "on the street or outside the town" in the plain church gown, not the surplice (Sehling 15, p. 622).

**The Sunday circuit.** Electoral Brandenburg kept the Sunday procession round the church, the *circuitus*, "with a pure responsory or other chant", without holy water (Sehling 3, p. 88; §13.15.2). The Havelberg visitors of 1558 show who walked in it. The pastor and chaplain lead it, the schoolmaster and his assistants sing, and the council and congregation follow. **Havelberg, *Abschied*, 1558** (Sehling 3, p. 232):

> Der pfarrer und caplan sollen ihrem berufe in predigen, sacramentreichung und sonst fleissig nachkommen, das creuze semtlich legen, desgleichen alle sontage und in hohen festen den circuitum mit gesengen, vormuge hochgedachts unsers gnedigsten herrn christlichen kirchenordnung, halten, auch der rath samt der gemeine fein ordentlich volgen.

The pastor and chaplain shall diligently follow their calling in preaching, administering the sacrament and otherwise, [and] lay the cross together; likewise every Sunday and on high feasts hold the circuit with chants, according to the Christian church order of our most gracious lord aforesaid; and the council together with the congregation [shall] follow in good order.

(The phrase *das creuze semtlich legen* is obscure; it may refer to setting down the processional cross.)

**Entering the church and going to the altar.** The only evangelical entrance rite is Brandenburg's: "the priest who holdeth the Mass, together with his ministrants, in their customary church ornaments, according to the custom of each church", goes to the altar and says the *Confiteor* (Sehling 3, p. 68). Elsewhere the minister simply "steps before the altar". No order describes a clergy procession at ordination or installation, beyond the new prelate being led to the altar by the prince's commissioners in Württemberg (§13.11.3).

**Festal and civic processions.** Two orders describe processions of the whole town:

- **Hof 1592.** On Whit Monday the clergy, the prince's captain and officials, the burgomasters, the council and the whole town gather in St Michael's. With the schoolboys, crowned with wreaths and the younger classes "clothed white in their christening shirts", they go round the high altar and out in procession to the convent church, singing *Veni Sancte Spiritus*. The girls' schoolmaster with the girls and maidens follows the men, and the women come last (§13.14.3). **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 463):

> Uff diesen tag pflegt sich die ehrwirdige priesterschaft neben dem herren haubtman und andern fürstlichen dienern, auch bürgermeister und rat sowol die ganze gemein dieser stad nach gehörtem andern puls in sanct Michelskirchen, zu vorsamlen, von dannen mit der schulmeng (welche, so bald man zusammenschlegt, sich in die gedachte kirchen mit schönen krenzen wol geziret findet [R.: NB. Die inferiores dasses sollen mit ihren schönen batenhembdern weis bekleidet sein und ihre gehenge anhaben], umb den hohen altar gehet und das Veni, Sancte Spiritus choraliter, Sei lob und ehr mit hohen preis singet bis zur fördersten grosen tur gegen dem markt), in der procession in die klosterkirchen zu gehen [...] Uf die mannspersonen folget der jungfrauschulmeister neben seinen schulmegdlein und anderen jungfrauen und hinder denselben das weibervolk in gleicher ordentlichen procession

On this day the reverend clergy, together with the lord captain and other princely servants, and also the burgomasters and council as well as the whole congregation of this town, are wont to gather in St Michael's church after the second peal has been heard; and from thence, with the company of the school (which, as soon as the bells are rung together, is found in the said church well adorned with fair wreaths [margin: NB. The lower classes shall be clothed white in their fair christening shirts and have on their hangings], goeth about the high altar and singeth the *Veni Sancte Spiritus* in plainsong [and] *Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis* as far as the foremost great door toward the market), to go in procession into the convent church [...] After the menfolk followeth the girls' schoolmaster with his schoolgirls and other maidens, and behind them the womenfolk in like orderly procession.

- **Strasbourg 1598.** On the Wednesday after the election of the new *Ammeister* and the oath-day, the whole magistracy with all the officers of the city went "in an orderly procession from the Pfalz into the Minster". There a sermon was preached on the office of rulers and subjects, followed by prayer for good government and thanksgiving for the past year. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 592):

> Das den folgenden Mitwoch der gantze Magistrat Sampt allen Verampteten in einer ordenlichen Procession von der Pfaltz in das Münster geht, Da dann ein besondere Predigt von dem Ampt der Oberkeit und der Unterthanen gehalten Und nach vollendeter Predigt das gemeine Gebett umb glückliche unnd friedliche Regierung angestellet und zugleich Gott, dem Herrn, danck gesagt wird

That on the following Wednesday the whole magistracy, together with all that bear office, goeth in an orderly procession from the Pfalz into the Minster, where a special sermon is held of the office of the magistrate and of the subjects; and after the sermon is ended, the common prayer for a happy and peaceable government is made, and at the same time thanks are given to God the Lord [...]

**The sacrament to the sick.** The medieval sacrament was carried through the streets to the sick with a light and a bell, and the people followed. Feuchtwangen recalls how it was done "publicly by the parish priest, many following him" (Sehling 11, p. 406). The early Baden order of 1533, still on the old pattern, kept it. **Baden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 16, p. 510):

> das auch sollich Sacrament mit gepurenden Eernn, mit vorgeendem liecht und schellen umb oder uber die gassen getragen werden soll, ist im vorigen unnsers gnedigen herren ausschreiben lautter gnueg angezaigt, dabei man es peleiben last.

[...] that also this sacrament shall be carried about or over the streets with due honours, with light and bells going before, is shewn clearly enough in our gracious lord's former mandate, and there they let it rest.

The evangelical orders replaced this with the minister going to the house, with or without the sexton carrying the vessels (§13.8.2). Kronstadt in 1543 named what was dropped. **Kronstadt, *Reformationsbüchlein*, German version, 1543** (Sehling 24, p. 196):

> darumb ist beschlossen, das der dyener an kerczenn, schellen und ander gepreng, so dy ungelertenn zur abgötterey reyczent, mit denenn, dy yn geruffen habenn, mit dem prott und kelch zum haws des krankenn geen soll

Therefore it is resolved that the minister, without candles, bells and other pomp, which entice the unlearned to idolatry, shall go with them that have called him, with the bread and cup, to the house of the sick […]

**What was taken out of the processions.** The orders that abolished the processions also cleared out what had been carried in them:

- **Images and dramatic figures.** The Palatine reform of 1546, following Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 (§13.18.1), did away with "all spectacles and plays that were made with images: on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the sepulchre, on Easter Day with carrying about the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with drawing it up, on Whitsunday with letting down the dove" (Sehling 14, p. 93). Feuchtwangen in 1563 lists "processions with statues, banners, wooden crosses" (Sehling 11, p. 406).
- **Relics.** Veit Dietrich asks the magistrate to abolish "setting out and carrying about relics" (*heiltumb aufsetzen und umbtragen*) (Sehling 11, p. 550).
- **Banners.** The banners ended with the processions that carried them. Calenberg-Göttingen in 1542 abolished the "monkey-play" of running about in Rogation week "with the banners and saints", keeping the days with sermon, sacrament and litany (Sehling 6/2, p. 812). Teschen in 1584 forbade "the processions with the banners" (Sehling 3, p. 461). Leiningen-Westerburg in 1566 forbade carrying banners over the fields (Sehling 19/1, p. 227). Mecklenburg ordered its visitors to remove the banners and crosses from the churches. **Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 12 November 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 220):

> insonderheit unchristliche ceremonien und abgotterei abschaffen, auch die fanen und creuze, so man in papatu pflegt umzutragen, aus den kirchen hinweg thuen.

[…] and in particular abolish unchristian ceremonies and idolatry, and also put away out of the churches the banners and crosses which in the papacy they were wont to carry about.

- **The treasures.** The processional crosses, monstrances, *viatica* (pyxes for the sick) and *pacificalia* (paxes) of the old processions were inventoried by the visitors and turned to the common chest (for example Grimma 1529, Sehling 1, p. 573; Zahna 1528, Sehling 1, p. 714).

**Table of processions.**

| Procession | Who walks, in order | What is carried | Sources (§) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rogation (where kept) | cross; schoolboys; priests; men, maidens, women | cross | Stendal 1541; Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2, 13.18.4) |
| Sunday circuit (Brandenburg) | pastor and chaplain; schoolmaster and boys singing; council and congregation | — (holy water dropped) | Brandenburg 1540; Havelberg 1558 (13.15.2, 13.18.4) |
| Palm Sunday (Brandenburg) | "as of old" | — (the blessing of palms dropped) | Brandenburg 1540 (13.18.2) |
| Funeral | cross (schoolboy or sexton); schoolboys with schoolmaster; pastor and chaplains in surplices; coffin; mourners | cross or crucifix; lights (Brandenburg, "with measure"); bier | Brandenburg 1540; Waldeck 1556; Anhalt 1551; Prenzlau 1557; Freiberg 1538; Perleberg 1581 (13.9, 13.18.4) |
| Whit Monday and dedication festival (Hof) | clergy; prince's officers; council; wreathed schoolboys, younger ones in white; men; girls' schoolmaster with girls; women | wreaths and white shirts worn by the boys | Hof 1592 (13.14.3, 13.18.4) |
| Council procession (Strasbourg) | the whole magistracy and all officers | — | Strasbourg 1598 (13.18.4) |

| Procession | Who walks, in order | What is carried | Sources (§) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Wedding (*Kirchgang*) | bride with maidens, bridegroom with his company | the bride's wreath | §13.7 |
| Sacrament to the sick | old: priest with light and bell, people following; new: minister alone or with the sexton | old: light, bell; new: bread and cup, corporal, surplice | Baden 1533; Kronstadt 1543; Hohenlohe 1553 (13.8.2, 13.18.4) |
| Abolished | — | monstrance, holy water, banners, statues, wooden crosses, the Palm-Sunday ass, the Easter image, relics | §§13.18.1, 13.18.4 |

## 13.19 Tonsure, deconsecration and the deposition of ministers

**Rites of separation without rites.** Three medieval acts marked a person or thing as set apart for God, or withdrew that mark: the tonsure, which made a man a cleric; the consecration of churches and vessels, and their execration when profaned; and the degradation of a cleric, which stripped him of his orders piece by piece. The evangelical orders kept none of these as rites. The tonsure was abolished as a human ordinance. Churches, chapels, altars and vessels were taken out of use by order of the magistrate and turned to the use of the parish and the poor, without any rite of deconsecration. A minister was removed from office by a public sentence, not degraded.

### 13.19.1 The tonsure abolished

**A human ordinance.** The evangelical orders give no rite of first tonsure and no clerical tonsure. The Albertine visitors at Freiberg in 1537 counted the tonsure among "all human ordinances hitherto held necessary" which "shall be done away": "ringing other than for divine services, going with the cross, wearing tonsures and cowls, fast days" (Sehling 1, p. 466). The Schleswig-Holstein order of 1542 lists "shaving the tonsure" (*Platten scheren*) with holy water, the blessing of bells, anointing and the separate holy vestments among the inventions of the papists (Sehling 23, p. 83). Bugenhagen reminded Hamburg in 1529 that St Lawrence "wore no tonsure nor deacon's robe, yet was a deacon, as is written in Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3" (Sehling 5, p. 514).

**Old-believing clergy ordered to let it grow.** Where priests and monks remained, the magistrates forbade them the tonsure as a mark of the papal clergy. The Saxon visitors at the collegiate church of Altenburg in 1533 ordered the canons "to abstain from the offensive papal dress and tonsure" (Sehling 1, p. 515). Esslingen in 1532 (Moderate Reformed) laid a fine of ten florins on any chaplain or religious who had his crown shaved. **Esslingen, *Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen*, 10 August 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 371):

> Deßgleichen will ir ersam weißheit, das hinfüro kheiner derselbigen caplen, auch die ordenspersonen, khein kron oder blatten mehr scheren, besonder sich in demselbigen andern cristenlichen burgern gemeß halten unnd erzeigen und also khein sünderung, wie im bapstumb beschehen, machen oder undernemmen sollen, den welcher über das straffpar betretten, den wirdet ir ersam weißheit jedes verbrechen umb x gulden straffen. […] Daneben soll auch allen ordens personen gesagt und eingebunden werden, die ordensklaider von inen zulegen unnd die krentzlin vom haupt herab zuscheren und sich in klaidungen andern burgern gemeß erzeigen bey ernstlicher straff eines ersamen Raths.

Likewise their honourable wisdom willeth that henceforth none of the same chaplains, nor the persons of religious orders, shall shave any more a crown or tonsure, but shall hold and show themselves therein like other Christian burghers, and so make or undertake no separation as was done in the papacy; and whosoever is found punishable beyond this, their honourable wisdom will punish him ten florins for every offence. […] Moreover it shall be told and enjoined upon all persons of religious orders to lay aside their habits, and to shave the little crowns off their heads, and to show themselves in clothing like other burghers, on pain of the earnest punishment of an honourable council.

**One later case.** Sehling records that Heinrich Julius of Brunswick, postulated bishop of Halberstadt as a Lutheran child, received the first tonsure on 27 November 1578. It caused "great stir in Protestant circles" and was "sharply blamed by most", though Jakob Andreae called it an adiaphoron (Sehling 2, p. 464, editor's introduction).

### 13.19.2 Churches, altars and vessels returned to common use

**No execration.** The orders give no rite for deconsecrating a church or altar, and no rite of execration when a church was profaned. What they give are orders to remove altars, images and chapels decently and by authority, and to turn the material and the vessels to the use of the parish, the common chest and the poor.

**Orderly removal.** Strasbourg in 1525 (Moderate Reformed) forbade any burgher, cleric or layman, to remove or break "images, altars, panels, iron or stonework" on his own authority; anyone with a grievance was to bring it to the council (Sehling 20/1, p. 166). The Saxon visitors at Saalfeld in 1533 ordered the council to clear the churches of their screens, candles, banners and images and of all altars but one, to put pews in their place, to close the minster and pull down a chapel, using its stone and timber for the bridge. **Saalfeld, visitation order, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 654):

> Derwegen sol ein erbar rat alle gitter, kerzen, fanen, abgottische bildnus und hindernus und bevorn alle altarn bis uf einen und das gemeuer, so im augustiner kloster fur dem chor stehet, aus den kirchen reumen und abbrechen lassen, damit man an stat derselben stule machen und gottes wort deste bas hören und der hochwirdigen sacrament handelung sehen mogen. Insonderheit sol man die tumkirche zu St. Stefen zuschleessen und die capella in Niderhöfen abbrechen lassen, die stein und holzwerk zur brucken und ander notturft gebrauchen.

Therefore an honourable council shall cause to be cleared out of the churches and broken down all screens, candles, banners, idolatrous images and hindrances, and above all every altar save one, and the masonry which standeth before the choir in the Augustinian cloister; that in their stead pews may be made, and God's word the better heard and the administration of the most worthy sacrament seen. In particular the minster church of St Stephen shall be shut, and the chapel in Niederhofen pulled down, and its stone and timber used for the bridge and other necessities.

Württemberg in 1555 ordered the field chapels in which there was no preaching and no burial to be "broken down and razed", and complained that the duke still found them standing, and the little image-houses with their altars newly roofed (Sehling 16, p. 292).

**Vessels and vestments sold.** The surplus chalices, monstrances and vestments were sold for the common chest. The Schönewalde order of 1529 allowed the judge and jurors "to sell the superfluous chasubles and vestments profitably" for the chest (Sehling 1, p. 667). In the lordship of Homburg in 1605 the vestments, patens and chalices were to be sold, "one cup kept at each place", and all accounted for (Wittgenstein 1605, Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 149).

**But not to profane use.** The property itself remained God's. The Courland order of 1570 states the principle: what has once been given and hallowed to God's honour may not, under any pretext, be turned "to profane use", and its holders are to restore it (Sehling 5, p. 52). The Pomeranian synod of 1574 bade pastors see that church goods were not "transferred to profane uses" (Sehling 4, p. 490). The sacred character passed from the stones and vessels to the purpose they served.

### 13.19.3 The deposition of ministers

**Removal, not degradation.** No order has the medieval degradation, in which a bishop stripped a condemned cleric of his vestments and the instruments of each order in turn. A minister unworthy of office was deposed by sentence of the superintendent, synod or consistory, and the sentence was announced to the congregation. Wittenberg in 1542 removed from office a minister put in the ban (§13.16.2).

**Hesse 1566** (Moderate Reformed). Hesse gives the fullest procedure, under the heading "How ministers of the church shall be removed from office". For negligence: admonition by the elders, then sharper warning by the superintendent, then sentence before several pastors or in the synod, after which the deposed man must leave the parsonage. For a public scandal: immediate inquiry by the superintendent with neighbouring pastors, and sentence whether the accused is present or not. In both cases the sentence is read in his church on the next Sunday by another pastor, who bids the people pray for a new minister. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 211–212):

> So derhalben ein diener der kirchen durch großen unfleiß in seinem ampt oder offentlicher sünden halber, als trunkenheit, ehebruch, hurerei, diebstal, falsch schweren, aufrur, todschlag, ketzerei, spaltung oder dergleichen, des ampts sich selbst unwirdig macht, will es warlich vonnoten sein, daß ein solcher auch offentlich vor der ganzen gemein seines ampts entsetzet werde. […] Diesen gesprochnen sentenz des superintendenten soll den nechst volgenden sontag ein ander pfarherr von wegen des superintendentis oder des ganzen synodi in der kirchen, darin der beurlaubte zuvor

> geleret, nachdem das ganze ampt in der kirchen verrichtet, verkündigen. Auch soll man zugleich denjenigen, welchen dies gebüret, befehlen, daß sie nach einem andern beizeiten trachten und mitlerweil Gott den himlischen Vatter fleißig bitten, er wöl einen andern tüchtigen und fleißigen senden und geben.

If therefore a minister of the church maketh himself unworthy of the office by great negligence in his office, or by reason of open sins, as drunkenness, adultery, whoredom, theft, false swearing, sedition, manslaughter, heresy, schism or the like, it is truly needful that such a one be also publicly put out of his office before the whole congregation. […] This sentence pronounced by the superintendent shall be proclaimed on the next following Sunday by another pastor, on behalf of the superintendent or of the whole synod, in the church wherein the dismissed man formerly taught, after the whole service in the church hath been performed. And at the same time those whom it concerneth shall be bidden to seek in good time after another, and meanwhile to pray God the heavenly Father diligently that he will send and give another, apt and diligent.

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## 13.20 Other occasional rites

### 13.20.1 The visitation service

**Pfalz-Neuburg 1560.** The church visitation was the evangelical substitute for the bishop's visitation. At the parish level it had its own service. Pfalz-Neuburg's visitation order of 1560/1566 describes it:

1. Two stanzas of *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist*.
2. The public confession.
3. The last two stanzas (*Du süße Lieb, schenk uns deine Gunst*).
4. A collect, the epistle and the Creed (*Wir glauben all*).
5. A short sermon by the pastor.

One of the visitors then addresses the people in the prince's name. The youth are examined in the catechism in church, boys and men-servants on one side and girls and maids on the other. A second address follows, rebuking parents and masters for negligence, and the newly appointed censors are presented by name. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1560/1566** (Sehling 13, p. 140):

> Erstlich, wenn das volk versamlet, singet man zwei gsetz vom lied Nu bitten wir den Heiligen Geist. Darnach verlieset man die effentliche beicht. Zum dritten singet man die letzten zwen vers. Du süße lieb dein gunst und darauf volget ein collecten, auf die collect die epistel und nach der epistel singt man den glauben. Nach dem glauben tut der pfarrer ein kurze predigt. Nach gehaltner predig spricht einer aus den visitatoribus das volk an auf diese nachfolgende weise

First, when the people are gathered, they sing two stanzas of the hymn *Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist*. Thereafter the public confession is read. Thirdly they sing the last two verses, *Du süße Lieb, [schenk uns] dein Gunst*; and thereupon followeth a collect, upon the collect the epistle, and after the epistle the Creed is sung. After the Creed the pastor maketh a short sermon. After the sermon is held, one of the visitors addresseth the people after this manner following.

### 13.20.2 Rites treated in other chapters

Some occasional services are treated elsewhere, or only touched on here:

- **Prayer days and fast days.** Days of prayer against the Turk, plague, dearth and war, and the litany days, are in Chapter 12.
- **Private confession and absolution.** Confession before communion is outside the scope of this chapter; its relation to public penance is noted in §13.16.1 and §13.16.3.
- **Confessional oaths.** The oaths sworn by ministers, schoolmasters and church officers at ordination, installation and visitation are in Chapter 17.

### 13.20.3 Reservation of the sacrament

§13.8.2 shows the orders ending the carrying of the reserved sacrament to the sick. This section gathers what they say about reservation as such: keeping consecrated hosts after the service, whether for the sick, for later communicants or for adoration.

**Kept for the sick and for later communicants: Ansbach 1526.** One early Franconian decree still keeps the reserved sacrament. The diet of 1526 orders "all due reverence" to the sacrament in church and when it is carried to the sick through the streets. Whatever is left over after communion is not to be thrown away but kept reverently in the sacrament house for the sick and for other communicants. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied*, 1526** (Sehling 11, p. 91):

> sunder solchem heiligen sacrament in den kirchen und, wann das zu den kranken uber die gassen getragen würdet, alle gebürliche ererbietung geton [...] Und ob zu den zeiten und tagen, wann die communicanten das heilig, hochwirdig sacrament empfahen, ichts von dem sacrament uberblieb, so sol solchs nit verechtlich hinweg geton, sunder mit gebürlicher reverenz in den sacramentheuslein zu bewarung der teglich zufelligen kranken oder anderer communicanten behalten werden.

but [that] to this holy sacrament, in the churches and when it is carried to the sick over the streets, all due reverence be done [...] And if at the times and days when the communicants receive the holy, most worthy sacrament, aught of the sacrament remained over, the same shall not be put away contemptuously, but kept with due reverence in the sacrament houses, for the keeping [of it] for the sick that daily fall in, or for other communicants.

**A free thing, to be given up: Nuremberg 1528.** Two years later the Nuremberg theologians treated reservation as one of the "free things". Osiander's answer is that it is free, but that since it serves neither faith nor love it should be given up, after teaching, where the weak are not offended. **Nuremberg, *Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 134):

> Ob man das sacrament soll einsperren? [...] Antwort: Es ist auch frei. Darumb soll man das nutzlichst tun, das ist: wo es die schwachen nicht ergert, soll mans nach guter underrichtung underlassen und abtun; dann es dienet weder dem glauben noch der lieb etc.

Whether one should lock up the sacrament? [...] Answer: It is also free. Therefore one should do what is most profitable, that is: where it offendeth not the weak, one should, after good instruction, leave it off and put it away; for it serveth neither faith nor love, etc.

The Brandenburg-Nürnberg church order of the same year gives the reasons. Christ commanded the body and blood to be eaten and drunk, not locked up or carried about. The wine would spoil sooner than the bread. The sacrament can be consecrated in the presence of the communicants whenever it is needed. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 138):

> Von einsperrung des sacraments. Item dieweil wir des leibs und pluts Christi allein zu essen und drinken und nit in heusle zu sperren oder umbzutragen, aus dem wort Gottes bevelch haben, auch solch sacrament im wein ehe weder im prot, so es lang stunde, verdurb und bei solchem einsperren ganz kein nutz ist, sondern daraus vil ergernus volget und in gegenwertigkeit der communicanten consecrirt werden soll und mag, ist solch einsperren und umbtragen ditz sacraments zu unterlassen. Doch das solchs vor mit dem wort werd abgericht.

Of the locking up of the sacrament. Item, since we have command from the word of God only to eat and drink the body and blood of Christ, and not to lock them in little houses nor carry them about; also such sacrament in the wine would spoil sooner than in the bread, if it stood long; and in such locking up there is no profit at all, but much offence followeth therefrom; and it shall and may be consecrated in the presence of the communicants: such locking up and carrying about of this sacrament is to be left off. Yet so, that this be first set right with the word.

The great Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 makes it a rule: "they shall not keep, lock up nor carry about the holy sacrament" (Sehling 11, p. 184; §13.8.2). Hohenlohe 1553, Wolfstein 1574 and the Merseburg synod of 1544 say the same (§13.20.5).

**Old hosts not to be used: Transylvania 1547.** The church order of the Transylvanian Saxons forbids a priest to give communion from hosts consecrated long before and kept "in corners", without saying the words of the testament. Christ said "take, eat, drink", not "put it in a corner, lock it fast, serve it with candles and lamps". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung* (German version), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 235):

> 6. Man sol auch hernach nit leiden, das der priester die wort des heiligen testaments außlasse und wolt gebrauchen der partikel, die er nach sonderlichem segen wider die ordnung Christi etlich zeitlang in winckeln verschlossen hat gehalten. [...] 7. Darumb sol niemand aus unglauben solche ubrige consecriert partikel in derley gestalt zum

> communicieren brauchen oder zum ergernis inderthyn einschliessen und abgötterey damit treiben. Denn Christus spricht: Nempt hyn, esset, trincket und thuts. Er spricht aber nindert: Setzts in ein winckel, sperret fest zu, dienet im mit kerzen und lampen und tragts mit processen umb spaciern.

6. Neither shall one suffer hereafter that the priest leave out the words of the holy testament and would use the particles which, after a private blessing, against the ordinance of Christ, he hath kept shut up in corners for some time. […] 7. Therefore let no one out of unbelief use such leftover consecrated particles in such wise for communicating, or lock them up anywhere to offence and practise idolatry therewith. For Christ saith: Take, eat, drink and do this. But he saith nowhere: Set it in a corner, lock it fast, serve it with candles and lamps, and carry it about walking in processions.

The Latin version of the same order has the same rule (Sehling 24, p. 214).

**Forbidden late: Teschen 1584.** In the Silesian duchy of Teschen the custom was still alive in the villages in 1584. The order forbids the adoration of the sacrament, locking it "in the ciborium, as they call it", processions with banners, and the Holy Week sepulchre. **Teschen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 3, p. 461):

> Weil auch bei der messe und sonsten biesher sonderlich auf den dörfern viel abgöttische ceremonien gehalten worden siend und noch gehalten werden, als adoratio des sacraments, einsperrung des sacraments in das ciborium, wie sie es nennen, die processiones mit den fahnen und andere dergleichen abgötterei mehr, insonderheit der abgöttische miessbrauch in der marterwochen mit dem grabmachen und siengen vor dem grabe, diess soll alles gänzlichen hiermit ernstlich verboten und abgethan sein

Since also at the Mass and otherwise hitherto, especially in the villages, many idolatrous ceremonies have been held and are still held, as the adoration of the sacrament, the locking up of the sacrament in the ciborium, as they call it, the processions with the banners and other such idolatry more, especially the idolatrous abuse in Holy Week with making the sepulchre and singing before the sepulchre: this shall all be wholly and earnestly forbidden and done away herewith.

**No reservation for the next service.** No Lutheran order after Ansbach 1526 allows hosts to be kept from one celebration to the next. The orders instead count the communicants beforehand so that only enough is consecrated (§13.20.5).

**Veil, lamp and colour.** No order says anything about veiling the reserved sacrament, the ciborium or the pyx, or about the colour of a lamp, its glass or its candle. The lamp before the sacrament house appears only to be forbidden: Schönburg 1542 lets no sacrament be kept in the sacrament house "nor suffer burning lamps before it" (Sehling 2, p. 175). The Transylvanian order rejects serving the hidden hosts "with candles and lamps" (above). The lights that remain are those set on the table at a sick-communion in the house (§13.8.2).

#### 13.20.4 Good Friday: no Mass of the Presanctified

The medieval Good Friday rite gave communion, to the priest alone, from a host consecrated on Maundy Thursday and kept overnight at an altar of repose or in the Easter sepulchre. No evangelical order keeps the Mass of the Presanctified or an altar of repose. The orders either hold a full communion on Good Friday, consecrated like any other, or none.

**Communion as on a Sunday.** Bugenhagen's Brunswick order lets those who wish to commune after the Good Friday Passion do so "as is customary on Sunday after the sermon". There is no sung Mass and no ceremony before the sermon, because the Passion preached is a good ceremony for communicating. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 379):

> So etlike na der passien in stillen Frydage willen communiceren, so geve me dat sacramente, alse me plecht des Sundages na der predige, wowol dat up den dach de missensank unde geprenge vor der predige nicht geholden is. De gepredigede passie is eyn gut geprenge tome communiceren. Wente Christus secht: Sulck doht to myner gedechtnisse, dat is, alse Paulus secht, vorkundiget mynen döt etc.

If any after the Passion on Good Friday will communicate, let the sacrament be given as is the custom on Sunday after the sermon, although on that day the Mass-singing and ceremony is not held before the sermon. The Passion preached is a good ceremony for communicating. For Christ saith: This do in remembrance of me, that is, as Paul saith, shew forth my death, etc.

Hamburg 1529 repeats the passage word for word (Sehling 5, p. 506). At Rostock about 1560 the Good Friday service ends with communion. **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum*, about 1560** (Sehling 5, p. 290):

> Auf den stillen freitag sol man von 5 auf 6 die historiam passionis Christi dem volk furlesen nach den evangelisten. Darnach wird gesungen uf sieben und das officium gehalten, von sieben auf neun wirt geprediget und darnach die communio gehalten.

On Good Friday one shall read the history of the Passion of Christ to the people from five to six, according to the evangelists. Thereafter there is singing at seven and the office held; from seven to nine there is preaching, and thereafter the communion held.

Electoral Brandenburg in 1540 kept the Good Friday office with "the representation of the burial", but required "a complete consecration and administration of the sacrament" within it (§13.21.3). The Brandenburg order of 1572 has the Passion read at four in the morning "as of old", then "the sermon and communion" (Sehling 3, p. 102, from the editor's apparatus to the order of 1540). Waldeck 1556 has the solemn prayers of Good Friday said "before the communion" (Sehling 9, p. 277). The Hof order of 1592 provides music "under the communion" on Good Friday (Sehling 11, p. 439).

**The sepulchre abolished.** The burial of the cross or host in the Easter sepulchre, with its watch until Easter morning, went with the rest. Mülhausen in 1528 (Reformed) asks that "the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre, with other uses, be put down" (Sehling 20/2, p. 207; see Chapter 14, §14.6.6). Nuremberg reported to Goslar that "the sepulchre in the church" was no longer set up. **Goslar, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 232):

> Das gauckelspiel mit dem hergott und ezel am Palmtag, die passionspiel am Karfreitag werden nit mehr gespielt, das grab in der kirchen, das gespot myt der urstendt Christi wurth nit mehr furgenohmen, desgleichen das fewer am osterabent nit mehr gesegnet.

The juggling-play with the Lord-God and the ass on Palm Sunday, the Passion plays on Good Friday are no more played; the sepulchre in the church, the mockery with the resurrection of Christ, is no more undertaken; likewise the fire on Easter Eve is no more blessed.

The Feuchtwangen memorial of 1563 recalls the reformers rejecting "on Good Friday the laying of the cross in the sepulchre, and the watches that followed" (Sehling 11, p. 406), and Teschen in 1584 still had to forbid "making the sepulchre and singing before the sepulchre" (§13.20.3).

#### 13.20.5 The remaining elements consumed

Since nothing was to be reserved, the orders had to say what became of consecrated bread and wine left after communion. They answer in three ways: count the communicants so that little or nothing is left; have the minister or the communicants consume the rest; and never mix it back with unconsecrated bread and wine, pour it away or give it to the sexton.

**Consumed by the priest or the communicants: Merseburg 1544. Merseburg, *Synodalunterricht*, 1544** (Sehling 2, p. 18):

> Sollen auch das hochwirdig sacrament ausser der Institution Christi nicht in andere wege gebrauchen, umbdragen noch einsetzen. Wan auch etwas von particulen ader im kelch ubrig bleibt, sol nicht bei gesetzt ader wegegossen, sondern vom pristern oder communicanten, so des mahls des sacrament genossen, vollent absumirt werden.

They shall also not use the most worthy sacrament in any other way outside the institution of Christ, nor carry it about nor set it in [the sacrament house]. When also aught of the particles or in the cup remaineth over, it shall not be set aside or poured away, but be fully consumed by the priest or the communicants who have partaken of the meal of the sacrament.

**All distributed and used up: Pfalz-Neuburg 1543. Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 76):

> Und, wiewol er von anfang sol fleiß haben, das er alle ding dermaßen verordne und in acht habe, damit von dem heiligen sacrament nit uberbleib, so sol er doch insonderheit zu ende darauf sehen, das es alles ausgeteilt werde und aufgehe, wie Christus befohlen hat, da er spricht Luce 22 [17]: Dividite inter nos..., auf das sich kein beschwerliche oder ergerliche unschicklicheit zutrag.

And although from the beginning he shall be diligent so to order and have regard to all things that naught of the holy sacrament remain over, yet at the end especially he shall see to it that it be all distributed and used up, as Christ commanded when he saith, Luke 22 [17]: *Dividite inter vos*, that no grievous or offensive unseemliness befall.

**The pastor consumes the remains: Hohenlohe 1553. Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 72):

> Der pfarherr soll alsdann die reliquias sumiren und nichts laßen uberpleyben oder reservieren, auch sondere achtung haben in administratione utriusque partis sacramenti, damit kain inconveniens dem sacrament widerfarhe in effusione calicis etc.

The pastor shall then consume the remains and let nothing remain over or be reserved; and he shall also have special heed in the administration of both parts of the sacrament, that no mishap befall the sacrament in the spilling of the cup, etc.

**The pastor communes, and so takes the remains: Wolfstein 1574.** Thomas Stieber wants pastors always to commune with their people, for the example, and also so that the remains are consumed and nothing reserved. **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 575):

> Ist derhalben gut, das die pfarhern alweg mit communicirn umbs exempels willen. So dienets auch zue guter ordnung, damit die reliquiae sacramenti vom kirchendiener genummen und nichts vom hailigen sacrament dörf aufbehalten werden.

It is therefore good that the pastors always communicate with [the people], for the example's sake. So it serveth also for good order, that the remains of the sacrament be taken by the minister and naught of the holy sacrament need be kept.

Regensburg [1567] has the officiant commune last "and take what is left of the consecrated there" (Sehling 13, p. 463). The Danzig order of 1557, as Sehling describes it, wants everything blessed "to be used up cleanly, without leftover spilling or setting aside" (Sehling 4, p. 169).

**Not mixed back with common bread and wine: Lüneburg 1575. Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 660):

> So auch nach geschehener communion etwas von brodt oder wein ubrig bleibet, so wirt dasselbe nicht widerumb zu dem andern gemeinen brodt oder wein gethon oder weggesetzet, sondern wird von dem diener, so das ampt vorrichtet, genossen oder den andern communicanten nach gelegenheit gegeben.

If also after communion is done aught of the bread or wine remaineth over, the same is not put back again to the other common bread or wine, nor set away, but is partaken of by the minister who performeth the office, or given to the other communicants as occasion serveth.

**Not left to the sexton: Nuremberg 1545.** Veit Dietrich asks communicants to announce themselves so that the pastor knows how much to consecrate. "This disorder is fit in no wise", he says, that wafers and wine be carried to the altar without measure "and then the rest left to the sexton for his use at home". **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 531):

> Denn dise unordnung taug in keinen weg, das man oblaten und wein on gewisse maß auf den altar tragen und darnach das ubrig dem custer wolt lassen zu seinem brauch im haus nützen.

For this disorder is fit in no wise, that one should carry wafers and wine to the altar without certain measure, and thereafter would leave the rest to the sexton to use for his need in the house.

Württemberg 1536 likewise counts the bread by the number of communicants and measures the wine "so that at the last nothing remain in the cup" (Sehling 16, p. 107). The Limpurg visitors of 1611 still asked each pastor whether he consecrated more hosts than there were communicants, and what he did with any left over (Sehling 16, p. 629).

**The Melanchthonian view: Transylvania 1547.** The Transylvanian order takes the opposite line on the leftovers themselves. Better to lay on too many particles than to have to consecrate again, "for one need not be anxious about what is left over". The words of consecration are to be understood with their effect, "so that only that is consecrated which is handled, as what is taken, eaten and drunk". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Kirchenordnung* (German version), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 233):

> doch wo viel mit einander auff ein mal vorhanden sein, auff das niemand seines begeren betrogen werdt und die wort der consecration durch nachlessigkeit nit von newes widerumb gesprochen müssen werden, ists besser, das man mehr partickel einleg; darff sich darumb des ubrigen nit besorgen, denn die wort der consecration mussen mit der wirckung verstanden werden, auff das allein consecriert sey, das da gehandelt wird, als das man nimpt, isset und trincket.

yet where many are present together at once, that no one be cheated of his desire and the words of consecration need not through negligence be spoken anew again, it is better that one lay on more particles; one need not therefore be anxious about what is left over, for the words of consecration must be understood with their effect, so that only that is consecrated which is handled, as that which one taketh, eateth and drinketh.

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## 13.21 Rites of the feasts and seasons

The medieval year had rites that belonged to one day only: the blessing of candles at Candlemas, the ashes of Ash Wednesday, the palms and procession of Palm Sunday, the washing of feet and of altars on Maundy Thursday, the Passion, the solemn prayers, the showing of the cross and the sepulchre on Good Friday, the new fire, paschal candle, *Exsultet* and blessing of the font on Easter Eve, the vigils of Christmas and Easter night, and the figures and dove of Ascension and Whitsun. This section sets out what the evangelical orders kept of them. The blessings themselves are treated in §13.15.1, and the image plays in Chapter 12, §12.10.10.

### 13.21.1 The pattern

**Luther's rule.** Luther would have Holy Week kept like any other week, except that the Passion is preached, without the "juggling-work" of the old ceremonies and without eight hours of Passion-preaching on Good Friday. **Luther, *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts*, 1526** (Sehling 1, p. 16):

> doch nicht also, das man das hunger tuch, palmen schiessen, bilde decken und was des gauckel werks mehr ist, halten oder vier passion singen oder acht stunden am karfreitag an der passion zu predigen haben, sonder die marterwoche sol gleich wie ander wochen sein, on das man die passion predige des tages eine stunde durch die woche oder wie viel tage es gelustet, und das sacrament neme wer do wil.

yet not so that one keep the hunger cloth, palm-shooting, covering of images and whatever more of the juggling-work there is, or sing four Passions, or have eight hours of preaching on the Passion on Good Friday; but Holy Week shall be like other weeks, save that the Passion be preached an hour a day through the week, or as many days as one pleaseth, and that whoso will take the sacrament.

**What the orders kept.** Most orders follow Luther: the feast keeps its history, read and preached, its proper chant and hymns, and the Supper. A few, chiefly Electoral Brandenburg in 1540, kept much of the old ceremonial with the blessings removed (§13.21.3–13.21.5).

**What is not found.** The searches found none of the following in any evangelical order:

- the *Exsultet* or Easter *praeconium*;
- the Christmas Kalenda (the proclamation of the Nativity from the martyrology);
- the imposition of ashes on Ash Wednesday;
- the putting out of the paschal candle at Ascension.

The paschal candle and new fire appear only to be abolished, and the ashes only in the lists of abolished blessings. The only Ash Wednesday custom named is a folk one: the Sponheim visitors of 1560 complain of people choosing "a mayor or king" on Ash Wednesday (Sehling 18, p. 640).

### 13.21.2 Christmas and the night vigils

**Matins moved to the morning.** Christmas and Easter Matins were kept, but not at midnight. The Palatine reform of the collegiate churches in 1546 moves them "somewhat nearer the day than at midnight". Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 sets Christmas Matins at four in the morning "to avoid all manner of danger" (Sehling 13, p. 95). **Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 92):

> Weyhennacht und Ostermetten sollen gehalten werden etwas neher dem tag dan zu mitternacht in massen, wie oben de horis canonicis gesagt ist.

Christmas and Easter Matins shall be held somewhat nearer the day than at midnight, in such manner as is said above of the canonical hours.

Nicolaus Hausmann's Anhalt order of 1532 says why. The night watch at Christmas and Easter would not be bad in itself, but it had brought sorcery and wantonness, and people are sleepy at midnight. **Anhalt, *Ordnung* of Nicolaus Hausmann, 1532** (Sehling 2, pp. 542–543):

> Es wer auch nicht bose, das die christnacht und ostern mit der wache gehalden wurden, wie für alters. Man weis aber den grosen misbrauch und zeuberei, leichtfertickeit, auch fleischlich wollust, die sich begeben haben, davon dan mehr sunden kommen, wan gote gedint und sein ere gesucht. Das junge und grobe volk kan kegen dem morgen gleichwol zu gotis furcht und zucht gehalten [fehlt: werden] wie in mitternacht, und bas. Es ist auch iderman schleferig und ungeschickt zum gebete.

It were also not evil that Christmas night and Easter were kept with the watch, as of old. But men know the great abuse and sorcery, wantonness, also fleshly lust, which have come about thereby, whence more sins came than God was served and his honour sought. The young and rough folk can be kept in the fear of God and in discipline toward the morning just as well as at midnight, and better. Every man is also sleepy and unapt for prayer.

The Brandenburg visitors of 1574 still had to tell the council to drive out "the wicked boys who do all manner of knavery in the churches on Christmas night and Easter night" (Sehling 3, p. 167).

**The Christmas lessons.** Where Christmas Matins survived as a morning service, it kept three lessons, the third the genealogy of Matthew 1 (*Liber generationis*). This is the nearest the orders come to the Kalenda. **Naumburg, St Wenzel, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1537/1538** (Sehling 2, p. 71):

> und zue weihnachten list man drei lectiones und singt drei responsoria. Die erste lectio ist Esa. 9. Puer natus est nobis etc. Das ander evangelium Johannis, die dritte, liber generationis. 3. Alsdan thut man ein predigt vom fest, als zue Weinachten. Ex evangelio Luc. 2.

and at Christmas one readeth three lessons and singeth three responsories. The first lesson is Isaiah 9, *Puer natus est nobis*, etc.; the second the gospel of John; the third *Liber generationis*. 3. Then one maketh a sermon on the feast, as at Christmas, out of the gospel of Luke 2.

Nördlingen (in the revision of 1555) has the same three lessons, with the responsories *Hodie nobis caelorum rex*, *Hodie nobis de caelo* and *Verbum caro factum est*, and the *Te Deum* on the organ after the sermon (Sehling 12, p. 320). The Hof order of 1592 gives a full Latin Christmas Matins with invitatory, psalms, lessons and responsories (Sehling 11, pp. 412–413). The rocking of the Christ-child's cradle was abolished (Chapter 12, §12.10.10).

### 13.21.3 Candlemas, Ash Wednesday and Palm Sunday

**Candlemas.** The candles were no longer blessed (§13.15.1). What remained of the feast is its gospel and Simeon's song. Henneberg 1555 has the German *Nunc dimittis* sung "from the Sunday after Purification" (Sehling 2, p. 310), and the Mansfeld hymn list gives "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin" for the day (Sehling 2, p. 235).

**Ash Wednesday.** No order keeps the ashes or gives a rite for the day. The day appears only as the beginning of Lent and in the lists of abolished blessings (§13.15.1).

**Palm Sunday: the procession kept, the blessing dropped.** Electoral Brandenburg kept the old Palm Sunday procession and chants, but not the blessing of palms. The same paragraph orders the rest of Holy Week (§§13.21.4–13.21.5). **Brandenburg (Electorate), *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 88):

> Den palmentag sol man halten mit der procession und gesengen wie von alters, doch das die weihung der palmen vorbleibe, folgende die andern tage mit lesung der passionen, nach dem text der evangelisten. Den grünen donnerstag aber mit der ceremonien der füsswaschung (da es in gebrauch gewesen) und des abends nach der metten gepredigt werde, vom abendmal bis zur gefengnis Christi etc. Am guten freitag sol frue die passion aus allen vier evangelisten zusamen gezogen vollend dem volk furgetragen werden und zu rechter zeit sol das gewonliche amt volbracht werden, mit der representation der sepultur, wie von alters, doch das drinnen volkömliche consecration und administration des sacraments geschehe. Der osterabend sol mit gewönlichen solemniten und ceremonien volbracht werden, doch mit nachlassung der weihung des feurs [...]. So sol auch die osternacht mit der representation der auferstehung Christi, wie vor alters, gehalten werden und der ostertag neben den folgenden tagen sol mit gewönlicher herrligkeit zugebracht

> werden, dergleichen die vesper mit der solemnitet, bei der tauf gebreuchlich, und so denn ungetaufte kinder verhanden zur selben zeit, die sollen mit getauft werden.

Palm Sunday shall be kept with the procession and chants as of old, yet so that the hallowing of the palms be left off; the following days with the reading of the Passions according to the text of the evangelists. But Maundy Thursday with the ceremony of the washing of feet (where it hath been in use), and in the evening after Matins let there be preaching from the Supper to the taking of Christ, etc. On Good Friday early the Passion, drawn together out of all four evangelists, shall be set forth to the people in full, and at the right time the customary office shall be performed, with the representation of the burial, as of old, yet so that therein a complete consecration and administration of the sacrament take place. Easter Eve shall be performed with the customary solemnities and ceremonies, yet with the leaving off of the hallowing of the fire [...]. So shall also Easter night be kept with the representation of the resurrection of Christ, as of old; and Easter Day with the following days shall be spent in the customary glory; likewise the Vespers with the solemnity customary at baptism; and if there be unbaptized children present at that time, they shall be baptized withal.

**The *Gloria, laus*.** Where there was no procession, the processional hymn *Gloria, laus et honor* stayed in the service. Naumburg 1537 sings it figurally as the Palm Sunday introit (Sehling 2, p. 71), and Nördlingen likewise (Sehling 12, p. 323). At Hof in 1592 it was sung after the sermon by three choirs. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 439):

> Post concionem: Gloria, laus et honor tibi sit, item: Glori und ehr sei dir sanftmutiger, in dreien unterschidlichen choren, also das etliche discantisten, praeside cantore, für dem hohen altar das lateinisch, darnach der ganze chor, gubernante ludimagistro, gegenuber das deudsche und dann die megdlein allweg den versum intercalarem: Glori und ehr sei dir, singen.

After the sermon: *Gloria, laus et honor tibi sit*, item "Glory and honour be to thee, thou meek one", in three several choirs: so that some trebles, the cantor presiding, sing the Latin before the high altar; thereafter the whole choir, the schoolmaster governing, the German over against them; and then the little girls always the refrain, "Glory and honour be to thee".

Palm-shooting, the blessing of palms and the wooden ass were abolished everywhere else (Mülhausen 1528, Reformed, Sehling 20/2, p. 206; §13.15.1).

### 13.21.4 Maundy Thursday and Good Friday

**Maundy Thursday.** Brandenburg 1540 kept the washing of feet where it had been in use (§13.21.3). It is the only order found that does so. Elsewhere the foot-washing became a sermon: Regensburg [1567] preaches on John 13 at midday (Sehling 13, p. 477), and Wolfstein 1574 preaches on it "that the communicants be stirred to brotherly love and unity" (Sehling 13, p. 570). The day's chief rite was the Supper, with a sermon on its institution. The washing of the altars was dropped at Mülhausen in 1528 (Reformed) (Chapter 14, §14.6.6).

**Good Friday: the Passion and the solemn prayers.** The Good Friday service everywhere centres on the Passion read and preached. Schweinfurt keeps a Matins at five in the morning with three psalms and three lessons from the Passion, the reading of John's Passion "word for word" to the people, and the old Passion hymns. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 636):

> Vom Carfreitag. Morgens frü zu fünf uren soll metten gesungen werden. Drei antiphon, drei psalmen [...] Drei responsoria. Die drei lectiones sol der magister oder cantor aus der historien des leidens Christi ordenen. Denn sol der capellan auftreten und die historien des leidens Christi vom dem evangelisten Johanne beschrieben von worten zu worten dem volk fürlesen. Zu ende der passion sol man singen: Vexilia regis prodeunt, item: Crux fidelis. Collecten, Benedicamus. Auf disen tag so anders communicanten verhanden sind, sol das abentmal gehalten werden, weil solcher gebrauch vorhin alhier ist gewesen.

Of Good Friday. In the morning early at five o'clock Matins shall be sung: three antiphons, three psalms [...] three responsories. The three lessons the master or cantor shall arrange out of the history of the suffering of Christ. Then shall the chaplain stand forth and read to the people the history of the suffering of Christ described by the evangelist John, word for word. At the end of the Passion one shall sing *Vexilla regis prodeunt*, item *Crux fidelis*; collects, *Benedicamus*. On this day, if communicants be otherwise present, the Supper shall be held, since such use hath been here aforetime.

The Mülhausen preachers of 1528 (Reformed) kept the Good Friday lessons and the old solemn prayers "for the heathen, Turks, Circassians and Jews", but read them in German (Sehling 20/2, p. 207). Waldeck kept the solemn prayers as a fixed part of the day. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 277):

> Es sollen auch die Precationes solennes, wie sie bißher in den beyden Kirchen Cörbach und Wildungen gehalten worden, In allen Kirchen auff den Stillen Freitag vor der Communion mit fleiß gehandelt werden

The solemn prayers also, as they have hitherto been kept in the two churches of Korbach and Wildungen, shall be diligently performed in all churches on Good Friday before the communion.

The order prints them in full as *Precationes solennes pro singulis ordinibus et necessitatibus die Parasceues dicendae*, with German bidding prayers (§13.22.6).

**Length.** No order asks for a specially long service. Luther rejected eight hours of Passion-preaching (§13.21.1). Bugenhagen's Brunswick order holds half an hour of preaching on the Passion to be enough, for "the long, tedious Passion-preaching, as men were wont to do, is not profitable" (Sehling 6/1, p. 379). Württemberg 1535 kept Good Friday as a holy day "only in the forenoon, for the Passion" (Sehling 16, p. 134). The length came instead from reading the whole Passion harmony, as at Brandenburg and Waldeck.

**The cross and the sepulchre.** Brandenburg kept the "representation of the burial", but with a full consecration rather than the Mass of the Presanctified. Elsewhere the showing of the crucifix and the sepulchre were dropped (§13.20.4; Chapter 14, §14.6.6). Communion on Good Friday is treated in §13.20.4.

**Tenebrae.** The Holy Week Matins survived at Hof as an evening office, "formerly called Tenebrae", with lessons, the responsories *In monte oliveti* and *Vinea mea electa*, a German responsory and a sermon (Sehling 11, pp. 415–416). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 kept them "without all knocking, rumbling and din" (Sehling 13, p. 95).

### 13.21.5 Easter Eve and Easter

**No new fire and no paschal candle.** No evangelical order keeps the blessing of the new fire, the paschal candle or the *Exsultet*. Even Brandenburg, which kept Easter Eve "with the customary solemnities and ceremonies", left off "the hallowing of the fire" (§13.21.3). The Mülhausen preachers (Reformed) kept the consecration of the font on Easter Eve but thought the Easter candle unnecessary for it. They also dropped the fire-blessing and the daily procession to the font through Easter week. **Mülhausen, *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*, [1528]** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 207):

> Zum fünften: Am helgen obend der Ostern ist unser meinung, das man den touff conserver wie bisher, ouch nit von nöten achtend, das man ein osterstock dar zu habe. Des glichen, das für ze segen, mag mitt gutem fug underlassen werden. Und zum letsten: Das visitiern zum touff mitt der procession die acht tag on alle irrung und gfar wol mag ab gethon werden, doch so witt, das man die halb Vespern, die man vor by dem touff hatt gesungen, im chor sing, wie andere vesperen.

Fifthly: On the holy eve of Easter it is our mind that one consecrate the font as hitherto, yet not deem it needful to have an Easter candle thereto. Likewise the blessing of the fire may with good reason be left off. And lastly: the visiting of the font with the procession the eight days may well be put away without any error or danger; yet so far that the half Vespers which were formerly sung at the font be sung in the choir, like other Vespers.

**The resurrection represented.** Brandenburg 1540 kept Easter night "with the representation of the resurrection of Christ, as of old", that is, the Easter play at the sepulchre, and Easter Vespers "with the solemnity customary at baptism", baptizing any children then waiting (§13.21.3). An Easter Matins of 1544 from Bibra survives with the German *Te Deum*, *Christ ist erstanden* and *Verleih uns Frieden* (Bibra, described by the editor, Sehling 2, p. 268). Elsewhere the Easter image plays were abolished (Chapter 12, §12.10.10). The Easter *Leise* "Christ ist erstanden" is treated in Chapter 8, §8.10.2.

### 13.21.6 Ascension and Whitsun

**The None kept, the figures dropped.** The Palatine reform of 1546 keeps the festal None of Ascension and Whitsun, but without the water poured, the hosts thrown from the vault, the fire cast down, the figure of Christ drawn up or the image of the Holy Ghost let down. **Kurpfalz, *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 92):

> Die nonas am heyligen Auffartstag und Pfingsten sollen züchtiglich und bescheidenlich, wie bißher, gesungen und gehalten werden, ausgeschlossen das wassergiessen, auch kein hostien oben aus dem gewelb werfen noch kein feuer herabwerfen, darzu kein bildnus Christi aufziehen nach kein bildnus des heyligen geists herablossen, sonder soll mit dem singen und der predig, so daruf volget, gnung sein.

The Nones on holy Ascension Day and Whitsun shall be sung and kept modestly and discreetly, as hitherto, excepting the pouring of water; also no hosts shall be thrown from above out of the vault, nor fire cast down; moreover no image of Christ drawn up, nor image of the Holy Ghost let down; but the singing and the sermon that followeth thereon shall be enough.

No order mentions putting out or removing the paschal candle at Ascension. Pfalz-Neuburg's editor notes the old custom of burning it until Ascension (Sehling 13, p. 96), but the order itself abolishes the candle.

**Whitsun and baptism.** Several orders explain that the early church baptized only at Easter and Whitsun, and that this is why the two feasts were kept (Schwäbisch Hall 1527, Sehling 17/1, p. 43; Württemberg 1553, Sehling 16, p. 232). None restores the seasons of baptism.

### 13.21.7 Septuagesima and Trinity Sunday

**No farewell to the Alleluia.** No order in the corpus has the medieval "deposition" or farewell of the Alleluia at Vespers or Compline on the eve of Septuagesima (*Alleluia, dulce carmen*, the burial of the Alleluia). Luther's *Formula missae* states the opposite principle: Lent, Holy Week and Good Friday are not to be paraded with other rites than the rest of the year, "for the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church". **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Sed nec ipsam quadragesimam sive maiorem hebdomadam aut sextam feriam penosam aliis ritibus ostentare decet, quam alias quascunque, ne semimissa et altera sacramenti parte Christum amplius ludere et ridere velle videamur. Alleluia enim vox perpetua est ecclesiae, sicut perpetua est memoria passionis et victoriae eius.

But neither is it fitting to show off Lent itself, or the Great Week, or the sixth day [Good Friday] as penitential with other rites than any other [days], lest we seem to wish further to mock and deride Christ with a half-Mass and with one part of the sacrament. For the Alleluia is the perpetual voice of the church, as the memorial of his passion and victory is perpetual.

The Hildesheim order of 1544 repeats the phrase when it orders the children to sing the Alleluia with its verse, though without the long melisma. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 853):

> Alleluja, welckör eine ewige stemme der kercken ys, singen de kinder mit dem versche, doch utgelaten de velen noten, de men plach hinden antohengende.

The Alleluia, which is an everlasting voice of the church, the children sing with the verse, yet leaving out the many notes which men were wont to hang on at the end.

**The season still marked.** Other orders kept the old seasonal exchange without any rite of farewell. Electoral Brandenburg sings after the epistle "the Alleluia and the sequence, if one be kept, or according to the season a tract in Latin" (Sehling 3, p. 68). The Palatinate in 1546 and the Transylvanian order of 1547 likewise put a tract such as *Domine, non secundum* in Lent (Sehling 14, p. 96; 24, p. 223). At Hof in 1592 Septuagesima is marked by the Lenten Kyrie at Mass and the plain *Benedicamus dominicale* "from Septuagesima until the feast of Easter". The Septuagesima Vespers hymn *Dies absoluti praetereunt* is noted as "formerly sung" (Sehling 11, pp. 414, 436).

**The Athanasian Creed on Trinity Sunday.** Several orders make the Athanasian Creed the text of Trinity Sunday:

- **Regensburg [1567]** reads it at Trinity Vespers, after Isaiah 6 at the vigil and Genesis 18 and Matthew 3 in the morning.
- **Thüngen 1587** reads it at the vigil and on the feast (Sehling 11, p. 744).
- **Albrechtshain 1554** takes it as the text of the afternoon catechism sermon on Trinity (Sehling 1, p. 519).
- **Pomerania 1569** has it preached in German on Trinity afternoon in town and village. The Pomeranian hymn list and the Kolberg convent statutes of 1586 set it, in German, among the Trinity songs (Sehling 4, pp. 478, 502).
- **The Mecklenburg convents** sing it in German after the *Benedictus* on all the high feasts, Trinity among them (Chapter 12, §12.10.8).

**Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 478):

> Trinitatis. In vigilia zur vesper wird gelesen visio Jes[ajae] cap. 6. Früe - loco epistolae: Visio Abrahae, Gene[sis] 18. Evangelii loco die offenbarung der treifaltigkeit in der tauf Christi, Matth. 3. Zur vesper symbolum Athanasii.

Trinity. On the eve at Vespers is read the vision of Isaiah, chapter 6. In the morning, in place of the epistle, the vision of Abraham, Genesis 18; in place of the gospel, the revelation of the Trinity in the baptism of Christ, Matthew 3. At Vespers the Athanasian Creed.

**Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 477):

> Predigen am festdage Trinitatis. Am dage der hiligen drevoldicheit schal men na middage in steden unde up dörperen predigen dat düdische symbolum Athanasii, welckere herna volget, de gemeine van den personen der godtheit vlitich und errichten, nicht hoger kunst sick bevlitigen, alle christen vormanen, dat se to sölcker predige sick hüpich vorsamlen.

Preaching on the feast day of Trinity. On the day of the Holy Trinity one shall preach in the afternoon, in towns and in villages, the German Athanasian Creed, which followeth hereafter; [shall] instruct the congregation diligently of the persons of the Godhead, not study after higher art, [and] exhort all Christians to gather in numbers to such preaching.

The Pomeranian order of 1542 had already prescribed the *Quicunque vult* once a week before the sermon, with an antiphon *de Trinitate* (Sehling 4, p. 357). Its use at Sunday Prime and in the schools is treated in Chapter 10, and in the Mass after the gospel in Chapter 8.

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## 13.22 The litany, the suffrages and the bidding prayers at the Mass

**What the orders inherited.** The medieval rite knew three set forms of intercession besides the canon:

- the **Litany of the Saints**, sung in procession on St Mark's day and the Rogation days, and on Holy Saturday on the way to and from the font, before the first Mass of Easter;
- the **suffrages**, commemorations with versicle and collect, chiefly of the saints;
- the **solemn prayers** of Good Friday (*orationes sollemnes*): nine biddings, each with *Oremus*, *Flectamus genua*, *Levate* and a collect, for the Church, the pope, all orders, the emperor, the catechumens, all needs, heretics and schismatics, the Jews and the pagans.

**What they made of them.** The orders kept the first and the third in a new form and dropped the second. Luther's German Litany and his corrected Latin Litany (*Latina litania correcta*) of 1529 removed the invocation of the saints. They became the commonest set intercession of the evangelical churches: sung in place of the Mass when no one communed, inside the Mass, after the sermon, and on fixed weekdays, prayer days and Rogation. The Good Friday biddings survive in two orders. This section covers the Mass and the parish services that stood in for it; the Litany at the hours is in Chapter 10, §10.7.5. The general prayer of the church, including its bidding forms ("Lasset uns bitten für …"), is in Chapter 6 and is left aside here.

### 13.22.1 The Litany in place of the Mass

**When no one communed.** Where there were no communicants on a Sunday or feast, many orders replaced the Supper with the Litany. The Saxon visitors put it simply in 1529: "where there be communicants, the office of the Mass held; but where no communicants, the German Litany sung by the whole church" (Niemegk, Sehling 1, p. 616). Belzig (1529) has the Litany before the sermon (Sehling 1, p. 527), and Pomerania 1542 after it: "but chiefly let one read the Litany" (Sehling 4, p. 357). At Kempten (1553), on a Sunday morning without communicants, the people sing the Creed, the Our Father or a psalm, and two or three scholars then sing the German Litany, "the other scholars together with all the people answering" (Sehling 12, pp. 175–176). Pfalz-Neuburg sets out the whole service. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 77):

> so sol der priester nit in gewonlichem meßgewand, sonder in einem chormantel oder nur in seinem chorrock für den altar treten und es aller ding halten, wie oben gesetzt ist bis auf die gemeinen predig. Nach der predig aber sol man die gemein litanei singen mit einer collecta pro pace und dann mit dem Benedicamus Domino und gemeinem segen beschließen

then shall the priest go before the altar, not in the customary Mass vestment, but in a cope or only in his surplice, and hold all things as is set above, as far as the common sermon. But after the sermon one shall sing the common Litany, with a collect *pro pace*, and then close with *Benedicamus Domino* and the common blessing.

Mecklenburg made the Litany the whole of what followed the sermon. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 202):

> Wenn nicht communicanten da sind, sol es mit dem gesang und lection vor der predigt aller ding gehalten werden, wie oben beschrieben. Auch sol in der predig erinnerung und vermanung geschehen, das man ofter zur communion komen wolle, wie gemeldet. Nach der predigt aber sol allein die litanei gesungen werden.

When there be no communicants, it shall be held in all things with the singing and lesson before the sermon as is described above. Also in the sermon remembrance and exhortation shall be made, that men would come oftener to the communion, as is said. But after the sermon the Litany alone shall be sung.

Lüneburg 1564 repeats the rule word for word, adding the blessing and "Erhalt uns, Herr" (Sehling 6/1, p. 553). Grubenhagen named the Litany as the successor of the old "prayer Mass". **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1033):

> VII. Von der letanien, wie es darmit soll gehalten werden. Alle wochen, entweder am Mittwochen oder Freytage, und am Sondage oder feyrtagen, wen keine communicanten vorhanden sind, so sollen die parner und ihre pfarkinder die letanien, welche man vormaln die bettmessen geheissen, singen und halten, auch darvor ein capittel oder historien aus der biblien, entweder aus dem alten oder neuen testament, dem volk auf das allerkürzeste zur unterrichtung und lher vorgedragen und gelesen werden.

VII. Of the Litany, how it shall be held therewith. Every week, either on Wednesday or Friday, and on Sunday or holy days when no communicants are present, the parsons and their parishioners shall sing and hold the Litany, which aforetime was called the prayer-Mass; and before it a chapter or history out of the Bible, either out of the Old or New Testament, shall be set forth and read to the people as briefly as may be, for instruction and teaching.

**The weekday "Mass" of the Litany.** At Hof the weekday *Tagmeß* on Monday, Tuesday, Thursday and Saturday had no communion. It consisted of a hymn, a collect, an Old Testament chapter, the Litany, a New Testament chapter, a short hymn and the Our Father sung at the altar. **Brandenburg-Ansbach- Kulmbach, *Ordo ecclesiasticus* of Hof, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 455):

> Wird die litania, in gewiese teil dividirt, von drei oder vier reinstimmigen knaben an dem ort, do sie sonst die lateinische epistel an feierabenden lesen, mit dem angesicht zum chor gewendet gesungen, darauf der ander chor wie gebreuchlich respondirt.

The Litany, divided into certain parts, is sung by three or four boys of clear voice at the place where they otherwise read the Latin epistle on holy eves, with the face turned toward the choir; whereupon the other choir respondeth, as is customary.

The editor reports that the Litany was split into four, one part for each day, keeping the beginning and end every day. A petition for protection from "the Pope and the Turk" was added (Sehling 11, p. 455). It was dropped when there was a baptism.

**Suffrages in the Mass without communion.** The Transylvanian Saxons put the old suffrages in the same place. When no one communed, the Sunday service was a German psalm, a collect, a sequence or tract, and a New Testament chapter read in order to the people. **Transylvania, *Kirchenordnung* (Latin), 1547** (Sehling 24, p. 223):

> Finita lectione canitur symbolum fidei cum versiculo et collecta de sancta Trinitate. Huic adduntur reliqua suffragia pro rege, pro remissione peccatorum et pro pace cum suis versiculis et collectis, quae similiter cum Benedicamus Domino et benedictione populi finiuntur. Hoc quoque officium semper eodem ordine per totum annum servatur.

The lesson finished, the Creed is sung, with the versicle and collect of the Holy Trinity. To this are added the remaining suffrages, for the king, for the remission of sins and for peace, with their versicles and collects, which likewise are ended with *Benedicamus Domino* and the blessing of the people. This office also is kept always in the same order through the whole year.

The weekday "high office … when no communion is celebrated" has the same Creed "with the aforesaid suffrages, collects and *Benedicamus Domino*" (Sehling 24, p. 225), and the German version says the same (Sehling 24, p. 245). At Bibersfeld near Hall (1535) the pastor knelt before the altar after the opening psalm and prayed the Kyrie in German and "the *preces publicae* for all needful estates and concerns" before the epistle (Sehling 17/1, p. 101).

### 13.22.2 The Litany within the Mass

**Between the epistle and the gospel.** The Litany could take the place of the sequence or gradual:

- the Albertine *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545: "at times, in the stead of the sequence, sing the Litany in German" (Sehling 1, p. 300);
- Prussia 1568: between epistle and gospel "one singeth the Litany, or on feast days one of the German spiritual songs of the feast" (Sehling 4, p. 83);
- Lüneburg, Regensburg, Mansfeld and Aschersleben, given in Chapter 8, §8.8.9.

Veit Dietrich gives the ceremony for the small towns. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 498):

> In den kleinen flecken nach der epistel sollen vor dem mittel altar zwen oder drei schuler die litanei deutsch singen und der ander chor sambt dem volk drauf anworten. Zu letz das Da pacem drauf singen sambt einer collecten de pace wie oben.

In the small towns, after the epistle, two or three scholars shall sing the Litany in German before the middle altar, and the other choir together with the people answer thereto. At the last sing the *Da pacem* thereupon, together with a collect *de pace*, as above.

**During the communion.** At Amberg the Litany filled a long communion. **Amberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1550** (Sehling 13, p. 286):

> Chorus singet under der communion das Jesus Christus, unser Heiland oder Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet etc. oder, so der communicanten vil sein die litaniam und nachvolgends das Agnus Dei und zulest das commun.

The choir singeth during the communion "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland", or "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet" etc.; or, if the communicants be many, the Litany, and next the *Agnus Dei*, and at the last the communion.

**After the sermon.** This was the commonest place. The Litany was sung after the Sunday sermon, before the communion or at the close of the service, at:

- Haderslev 1528, every Sunday "with the whole people … in Danish" (Sehling 23, p. 65);
- Mecklenburg 1552, Lüneburg 1564 and Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 when there was no communion (§13.22.1);
- Waldeck 1556 and many others.

Waldeck describes the posture. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 277):

> Nach der Predigt sollen etliche der Schüler oder der Pfarrherr, vor dem Altar niderkniend, die Litanei, wie in D. Luthers seligen Sangbüchlin beschrieben, mit heller stimm und verstendtlichen worten singen und der Chor darauff antworten. Darauff soll der Pastor mit eyner Collecten, wie daselbst stehet, Und der Chor mit dem gesenge: O herre Gott, gib uns deinen fried, etc. beschliessen.

After the sermon certain of the scholars, or the parson, kneeling before the altar, shall sing the Litany as it is described in Dr Luther of blessed memory's little song-book, with clear voice and intelligible words, and the choir answer thereto. Thereupon the pastor shall close with a collect, as it standeth there, and the choir with the song, "O Lord God, give us thy peace", etc.

In Mecklenburg the pastor sang it from the pulpit. **Mecklenburg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1542** (Sehling 5, p. 149):

> Zum dritten soll der pastor am sontage nach der predigte in stetten und dorfern die letanei dem volke vom predigstuel mit andacht fursingen und die schuler oder der kuster samt dem volke sollen niderkniegen und ime darauf antwurten.

Thirdly, the pastor shall on Sunday after the sermon, in towns and villages, sing the Litany before the people from the pulpit with devotion, and the scholars or the sexton together with the people shall kneel down and answer him thereto.

On its prayer days Nassau-Weilburg (1576) closed the service with the Litany or "Erhalt uns, Herr". Since the Litany covers "all needs that the Christian congregation has to lay before God", it was to alternate with the full set of prayers rather than be added to them (Sehling 10, p. 238).

**Before the Introit.** Regensburg 1542 and Transylvania 1547 put the Litany at the head of the service (Chapter 3).

**Ordination within the Litany.** Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel ordained preachers on a weekday "after the sermon and the Latin Litany" (Sehling 6/1, p. 69). At Lüneburg the ministers went to the altar at a fixed petition of the Litany. **Lüneburg,**

***Kirchenordnung der Stadt*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 655):

> Wen der genante tag erscheinet, die predigt gehalten und in der litania diese wort gesungen werden: O Jesu Christ, Gottes Sohn, so gehet das ganze ministerium mit dem ordinando vor den hohen altar, knien daselbst samptlich nidder und hebet der superintendens oder wehr das ampt der ordinierung vorwalten soll, ahn zu singen: Veni, sancte Spiritus etc.

When the appointed day cometh, the sermon is held, and in the Litany these words are sung, "O Jesu Christ, God's Son", then goeth the whole ministry with the ordinand before the high altar, and they kneel there all together, and the superintendent, or whoso shall administer the office of ordaining, beginneth to sing *Veni, sancte Spiritus* etc.

Ordination itself is treated in §13.10.

#### 13.22.3 The forms and the singers

**Luther's two Litanies.** The orders name Luther's German Litany and his corrected Latin one, "as it is printed and gone forth at Wittenberg" (Calenberg 1542, Sehling 6/2, p. 812). The Latin Litany belonged to the school and the hours, and the German one to the congregation:

- Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel 1543: the Latin Litany at the eve Vespers and at an ordination, the German "once in the week after the sermon, that the whole church answer" (Sehling 6/1, p. 51);
- Pomerania 1535: the Latin Litany at the boys' Saturday Vespers, and the German Litany once a week with the people (Sehling 4, pp. 340, 342).

Prussia had a Litany of its own, used at Regensburg (Chapter 8, §8.8.9). Marggrabowa insisted on Luther's prose text.
**Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 4, p. 149):

> Alle freitage soll man die litanei singen, wie es D. Luther gemacht und nicht reimweise, und sollen zwen oder drei knaben furm altar knien oder singen, darauf der capellan ein kurzen sermon auswendig tun soll.

Every Friday one shall sing the Litany as Dr Luther made it, and not in rhyme; and two or three boys shall kneel before the altar and sing, whereupon the chaplain shall make a short sermon without book.

**Who sang it, and how.** The usual pattern was two or three boys, kneeling before the altar or standing at the epistle place, with the choir and people answering. Nördlingen 1579 prints the Litany in two columns for alternating choirs, ending "Both choirs together: *Kyrie eleison. Amen*" (Sehling 12, p. 369). At Brandis in 1574 the Litany after the Thursday sermon alternated week by week between the sung setting "made by Doctor Justus Jonas" and Luther's (Sehling 1, p. 534). Where there was no school the Litany was read:

- at Limpurg in 1610 the town of Gaildorf sang it "before the altar", but in the villages the pastor read it from the pulpit (Sehling 16, p. 617);
- Zweibrücken 1533 allowed it "sung or read, as the place alloweth" (Sehling 18, p. 52).

#### 13.22.4 The Litany days

**Weekly.** The Litany was most often fixed to a weekday:

- **Wednesday and Friday:** the Reuss articles of 1528, "in all ways to hold the Litany on Wednesdays and Fridays" (Sehling 2, p. 143); Grubenhagen 1544 (above);
- **Friday:**
  - the Ansbach chapters 1533 (Sehling 11, p. 314);
  - Mecklenburg 1542, where the people were "to help the scholars sing" it, "as is held on Sunday" (Sehling 5, p. 149);
  - Marggrabowa 1581 (above);
  - Nördlingen 1579, "commonly on Friday after the sermon" (Sehling 12, p. 369).

The calendar of prayer days, Ember days and fasts on which the Litany was sung is set out in Chapter 12, §§12.6.2, 12.10.11, 12.12.7. That chapter gives the Albertine Ember-week Litany (Saxony 1539) and the Zweibrücken prayer days. Mansfeld (1580)

wanted the German Litany "often and much, especially on the four Ember seasons, when the people are together" (Sehling 2, p. 239).

**Rogation.** The Litany kept its oldest home in Rogation week, without the procession and the saints. Calenberg 1542 abolished the procession but kept the prayer days "with preaching, administering the sacrament, and the Litany early in the morning". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1542** (Sehling 6/2, p. 812):

> Es sol aber die letania nicht wie in vorigen zeiten, da man sang: Sancte Petre, ora pro nobis!, sonder auf weise und masse, wie sie zu Wittemberg gedruckt und ausgangen ist, gehalten werden.

But the Litany shall be held, not as in former times, when men sang *Sancte Petre, ora pro nobis!*, but after the manner and measure in which it is printed and gone forth at Wittenberg.

Elsewhere at Rogation:

- the Heidelberg chapter in 1546 was to sing "no litany *in rogatoribus* with invocation of the saints, but the right Litany with invocation of the name of God" (Sehling 14, p. 92);
- Brandenburg 1572 preaches "of prayer" through Rogation week and sings the Litany (Sehling 3, p. 102).

Pomerania 1569 gives the whole week the Litany and a penitential character. **Pomerania, *Agenda*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 466):

> Darümme schal men disen sondach unde de volgende weke, ane den dach Ascensionis domini, vam hiligen gebede predigen unde de letanien singen, de gemeine ernstlick vormanen, dat ein jeder vlitich tor kercke ga unde de sinen tom gebede holde. […] Up disen sondach unde in der weke schal men kenen figural sang singen, ock nicht orglen, utgenamen den dach Ascensionis domini, mit der in vigilia: sunder idel düdische psalmen singen, bedepsalmen, boetpsalmen, vader unse etc. stede nevenst dem sermon letanien holden.

Therefore one shall preach on this Sunday and the following week, save the day of the Ascension of the Lord, of holy prayer, and sing the Litany, and earnestly exhort the congregation that every one go diligently to church and keep his household to prayer. […] On this Sunday and in the week one shall sing no figured song, nor play the organ, except the day of the Ascension of the Lord with its vigil, but sing only German psalms, prayer-psalms, penitential psalms, the Our Father etc., [and] always hold the Litany beside the sermon.

#### 13.22.5 The Litany at the feasts and seasons

**Advent and Lent.** In Pomerania the Litany marked the penitential seasons. In Advent the village pastors were to read Matthew 24–25 at the Friday or weekday sermon "and thereupon hold the Litany" (Sehling 4, p. 471). The Latin Litany replaced the *Magnificat* when Vespers were kept "*dominicaliter*, as in Advent and Lent" (Pomerania 1542; Chapter 10, §10.7.5).

**The high feasts.** Several orders tie the Litany to the great feasts. Zweibrücken is the earliest. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *12 Artikel "Form und Maß"*, 1533** (Sehling 18, p. 52):

> Where auch guth, das ungeverlich vier male im Jhar, als in den weiennachten, Ostern, pfingstwochen und nach Exaltationis Crucis, christlich Letani gesungen oder gelesen wurde nach gelegenheit des orts.

It were also good that about four times in the year, as in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks and after the Exaltation of the Cross, a Christian Litany were sung or read, according to the circumstances of the place.

Two later witnesses follow:

- **Zweibrücken 1574** made the two days after Christmas, Easter and Whitsun "common prayer days", with preaching in the morning only and the Litany sung or read after the sermon (Sehling 18, p. 519; Chapter 12, §12.6.2).
- **Danzig.** A list of feast days printed by Sehling as a draft for the order of 1567 names the feasts "with several Masses, Vespers, litanies through the choir, and four sermons". These are the Sundays, Trinity, Easter, Whitsun and Christmas with the two days following, and the other high feasts (Sehling 4, p. 186).

**Easter Eve and Easter Day: a negative.** No order puts a Litany on Easter Eve, before or after the font, or on Easter Day itself. The medieval Holy Saturday Litany went with the blessing of the font and the Easter candle, which nearly all the orders gave up

(§13.21.5). The Easter Litany survives only in the Easter-week prayer days of Zweibrücken and the "litanies through the choir" of the Danzig feast list. No Sehling order has a Litany sung at an Easter Vigil.

### 13.22.6 Good Friday: the Litany and the solemn prayers

**The Litany on Good Friday.** Two southwestern orders make the Litany the intercession of the day. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 166):

> Und so Communicanten vorhanden seyen, sol das Abentmal auff den Grünen donnerstag und Charfreytag wie an den Sontagen, doch mit vorgehender Predig, gehalten werden. Es sol auch am Charfreytag ein predig vom gmeinem Gebeet gethon und die Litaney für alles anligen der Christlichen kirchen gehalten werden.

And if communicants be present, the Supper shall be held on Maundy Thursday and Good Friday as on the Sundays, yet with a sermon going before. There shall also on Good Friday be a sermon made of the common prayer, and the Litany held for all the concerns of the Christian church.

The revision of 1615 keeps it: on Good Friday the communion "with a sermon going before on prayer, whereupon the Litany shall be sung" (Sehling 17/1, p. 165). Limpurg (1610) has the pastors on Good Friday "read the Litany together with the prayer" (Sehling 16, p. 621). The choice is deliberate: a sermon on prayer and the Litany, which prays for all estates, take the place of the old solemn prayers for all orders of men.

**The solemn prayers in German: Waldeck 1556.** Only Waldeck kept the solemn prayers as a set of biddings and collects. They were to be used "in all churches on Good Friday before the communion" (§13.21.4). The order prints them in full as *Precationes solennes pro singulis ordinibus et necessitatibus die Parasceues dicendae* (Sehling 9, pp. 277–282). Each has a Latin heading, a German bidding addressed to the people ("Wir wöllen auch bitten für …" or "Lasset uns auch bitten für …"), and an *Oratio*. There are eleven intentions:

1. the Church;
2. *pro ministris verbi et ecclesiae*;
3. *pro catechumenis*;
4. *pro errantibus in fide*;
5. *pro persecutoribus Verbi et Ecclesiae*;
6. *pro magistratibus*;
7. *pro iudaeis*;
8. *pro pseudochristianis*;
9. *pro inimicis*;
10. *pro tentatis et sub cruce laborantibus*;
11. *pro peccatis nostris*.

They open with an address to the "dear brothers and sisters" and Christ's promise to those who ask. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 278):

> Dieweil wir dann ytzundt im namen des herrn versamlet sein, so laßt uns erstlich von hertzen bitten für die Gemeyne Christlichen Kirchen, das sie der allmechtige Gott durch unsern herrn Jesum Christ inn der gantzen welt beschirmen und erhalten wölle, das sie mit ruhe und fried nach seinem Göttlichen willen leben und seinen heyligen Namen loben unnd preisen mögen.

Since we are now gathered in the name of the Lord, let us first pray from the heart for the congregation of the Christian Church, that Almighty God through our Lord Jesus Christ will protect and preserve it in all the world, that it may live in rest and peace according to his divine will, and laud and praise his holy name.

The bidding for the Jews keeps the old intention but drops the old language of "perfidy" and "blindness" for the veil of 2 Corinthians 3 and the olive tree of Romans 11. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556** (Sehling 9, p. 280):

> Pro iudaeis Lasset uns auch bitten für den elenden uberlauff des Jüdischen Samens, Das yhnen der barmhertzige Gott seine alte verheyssung gnediglich in yhren hertzen erwecken wölle und vor yhren augen unnd hertzen die decken hinweg nehmen, das sie auch zu erkentnus Jesu Christi, unsers herrn, mogen kommen. Oratio: Barmhertziger, gütiger

> Gott, Der du auch der Juden hertigkeyt von deiner erbarmung nit außschleussest, Gedencke deines gnedigen bunds, den du mit deinem trewen diener Abraham und mit andern lieben vättern auffgerichtet hast.

For the Jews. Let us also pray for the wretched remnant of the seed of the Jews, that the merciful God would graciously awaken in their hearts his old promise, and take away the veil from before their eyes and hearts, that they also may come to the knowledge of Jesus Christ our Lord. Prayer: Merciful, kind God, who shuttest not out even the hardness of the Jews from thy mercy, remember thy gracious covenant which thou didst set up with thy faithful servant Abraham and with other dear fathers.

**What changed from the Roman order.**

- *Kept*: the Church, the clergy, the catechumens, the rulers, those in error, the Jews, and the afflicted. The Roman "all needs" becomes "the tempted and those labouring under the cross", with a long list: hunger, pestilence, wild beasts and the sword, prisoners, exiles, the sick, widows and orphans, and women in childbirth.
- *Dropped*: the pope; the pagans; the *Flectamus genua* and *Levate*. The people are bidden, but no kneeling and rising is prescribed.
- *Added*: persecutors of the word, false Christians, enemies, and our own sins.

**Mülhausen 1528** (Reformed). The Mülhausen preachers had earlier kept the Roman prayers in German, "the collects which are prayed for the estates, namely for heathen, Turks, Circassians and Jews" (Sehling 20/2, p. 207; §13.21.4).

**What was not found.** No other order prints or prescribes the Good Friday solemn prayers. No order has *Flectamus genua* or *Oremus, dilectissimi*, and no order keeps the prayer *pro perfidis Iudaeis*. Elsewhere the Good Friday intercession was the Litany, or the ordinary general prayer after the Passion sermon.

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## 13.23 Table by order

**How to read the table.** The table lists the orders that give the principal forms. For each order it shows which rites it supplies in full or in quotation, and what it abolishes. Section numbers refer to this chapter.

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Taufbüchlein* 1523 and 1526 | baptism with the received ceremonies (13.3.2); revised baptism (13.3.3) | salt, spittle, oil, chrism, candle in 1526 (13.3.3) |
| Luther, *Traubüchlein* 1529 | betrothal and marriage at the church door and before the altar (13.7.1) | the nuptial Mass |
| Luther, ordination form 1539 | ordination with laying on of hands (13.10.2) | episcopal consecration |
| Saxony (Ernestine), *Unterricht der Visitatoren* 1528 | weather-ringing kept as a call to prayer (13.15.5) | the trust in blessed bells |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Kirchenordnung* 1539 | baptism with exhortation (13.3.4); emergency baptism (13.3.7); communion of the sick (13.8.3); funerals (13.9.2) | extreme unction (13.8.1) |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Gemeiner Bericht* 1540 | — | churching of women and brides, sprinkling, salt and water, weather-ringing (13.5.1) |
| Electoral Saxony, Wittenberg consistory 1542 | communion of the sick (13.8.2); form of excommunication and reconciliation (13.16.2) | reserved sacrament (13.8.2) |
| Electoral Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation* 1545 | confirmation (13.6.1); ordination (13.10.1) | — |

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Saxony, *Ordnung* of Duke August 1580 | godparents (13.3.8); confirmation (13.6.7); investiture of pastors (13.11.1); *Kirmes* dancing limited (13.14.4) | weather-ringing and bell baptism (13.15.5) |
| Electoral Brandenburg 1540 | baptism with oil of catechumens, chrism, white cap and candle (13.3.2, 13.15.4); private confession and absolution with laying on of hands (13.17.3); Sunday, Palm Sunday and Rogation processions (13.18.2); confirmation (13.6.4); Sunday procession without water (13.15.2) | blessings of water, salt, herbs, candles (13.15.2) |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533 | baptism with exhortations (13.3.1, 13.3.4); marriage (13.7.2); funerals (13.9.3) | churching (13.5.1); oil and salt at baptism (13.3.2); font blessing 1528 (13.15.3); the yearly blessings (13.15.1) |
| Nuremberg, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein* 1545 | exorcism glossed as prayer (13.4.1); the dying (13.8.4); the condemned (13.8.6); funerals (13.9.1) | — |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach | marriage, Hof 1592 (13.7.4); dedication of 1572, its yearly festival and the school dedication of 1546, Hof 1592 (13.14.3) | exorcism mitigated 1591–1594 (13.4.3) |
| Württemberg 1536 and 1553 | baptism (13.3.5); visitation of the sick (13.8.2); marriage and the wreath (13.7.6); investiture of prelates (13.11.3) | exorcism (13.3.5) |
| Strasbourg 1525 and 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | baptism (13.3.5); marriage with the impediments asked thrice (13.7.3) | exorcism (13.3.5); oil and chrism, 1525 (13.15.4) |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed to 1566; Philippist, 1574) | confirmation, Ziegenhain 1539 (13.6.2); ordination of elders and deacons 1566 (13.12.1); deposition of ministers 1566 (13.19.3); ordination, Agende 1574 (13.10.5) | dedications, Homberg 1526 (13.14.1) |
| Calenberg-Göttingen 1542 | confirmation (13.6.3) | blessings of salt, water, herbs, palms, *Fladen* (13.15.1) |
| Mansfeld 1554 and 1580 | godparents (13.3.8); churching as thanksgiving (13.5.2); confirmation (13.6.5); funerals (13.9.4); ban, open penance and absolution (13.16.5) | — |
| Pomerania 1569 | exorcism (13.4.1); prayer over the possessed (13.8.7) | — |
| Regensburg | ordination 1553? (13.10.4); funerals 1560 (13.9.4); plague order 1562 (13.8.5); dedication anniversary about 1567 (13.14.3) | — |
| Merseburg 1545 | ordination within the Mass (13.10.3) | — |
| Schleswig-Holstein 1542 | ordination of bishops (13.11.4) | — |
| Kurpfalz (Lutheran 1556, 1577 and 1580; Reformed 1563, 1572 and 1592) | Luther's catechism form of confession, 1556 (13.17.2); Reformed baptism (13.3.6); annulment, 1563 (13.7.10); ordination (13.10.5); presentation of ministers (13.11.2); installation of elders 1592 (13.12.1); stewards' oath 1577 (13.12.4); schoolmaster's promise 1580, Heidelberg bell-ringer 1572 (12.2–12.3); exclusion by elders (13.16.8) | emergency baptism by women; exorcism (13.3.6) |
| Saxe-Lauenburg 1585 | churchwarden's oath (13.12.4); lesser and greater ban; public penance and absolution (13.16.1, 13.16.3) | — |

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg 1570 | consistory process, form of excommunication, absolution from the ban (13.16.4) | — |
| Wertheim 1530/1555 | the pastor's examination at the betrothal (13.7.8) | secret betrothals |
| Saxony (Albertine), *Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung* 1556 | divorce for adultery (13.7.10) | — |
| Electoral Brandenburg 1573 | remarriage of the innocent divorced party (13.7.10) | — |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539 | visitation of the sick by James 5 (13.8.1) | the oil of the sick (13.8.1) |
| Lippe 1538 | the gospel in place of the last oil (13.8.1) | extreme unction (13.8.1) |
| Esslingen 1532 (Moderate Reformed) | — | the tonsure (13.19.1) |
| Saalfeld 1533 | — | altars, images, a chapel (13.19.2) |
| Grubenhagen 1581 | lesser and greater ban (13.16.1); absolution from the ban (13.16.6) | — |
| Micron's *Ordinancien* 1554 (East Frisia 1565) (Reformed) | installation of elders and deacons (13.12.1); Reformed excommunication and readmission (13.16.7) | — |
| Lippe 1571 | the sexton's pledge (13.12.2) | charms and amulets (13.12.2) |
| Leisnig 1529 | election of churchwardens (13.12.4) | — |
| Lüneburg 1564 | appointment of midwives (13.12.5) | — |
| Mulhouse 1551 (Reformed) | the schoolmaster's oath (13.12.3) | — |
| Gengenbach 1536 (Moderate Reformed) | the schoolmaster's appointment (13.12.3) | — |
| Hildesheim 1581 | the organist's contract (13.12.3) | — |
| Strasbourg 1523 (Moderate Reformed) | the oath of the steward of the poor (13.12.4) | — |
| Strasbourg 1531 (Moderate Reformed) | appointment of *Sigristen* (13.12.2) | — |
| Sayn 1590 | surety for the bell-ringer who keeps the vessels (13.12.2) | — |
| Anhalt 1594 (Philippist) | the sexton's yearly appointment (13.12.2) | — |
| Nördlingen 1544 | examination of the sick-women by the pastor (13.12.6) | — |
| Heilbronn 1531 | the beguines' troth and instruction (13.12.6) | — |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, Keppel 1570 | clothing of a nun with questions, oath, sermon and exhortation (13.12.7); election, oath and presentation of the *domina* (13.12.8) | binding vows; the convent as a prison (13.12.7) |
| Lüneburg 1574 | clothing under the duke's command (13.12.7); burial in a linen sheet (13.12.10) | cowl, veil and crown (13.12.7, 13.12.10) |

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg 1555 | admission by the council (13.12.7); promise of the mother and council-mothers (13.12.8) | — |
| Schleswig-Holstein after 1610 | election of abbess and prioress under oath; the sisters' oath of obedience (13.12.8) | — |
| Württemberg 1535 and 1552 | — | admission of monks, nuns, beguines and Lollards; novices' vows (13.12.7, 13.12.9) |
| Goslar, Frankenberg 1542 | — | admission to the habit (13.12.7, 13.12.9) |
| Esslingen 1535 (Moderate Reformed) | settlement or maintenance of the friars (13.12.9) | — |
| Pfalz-Simmern, Ravengiersburg 1560 | reception of novices as scholars; the stipendiary's obligation (13.12.9) | — |
| Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel 1569 | words for laying aside the habit (13.12.10) | — |
| Schwäbisch Hall 1543/1615 | council-election sermon (13.13.1) | consecration of churchyards (13.14.1) |
| Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 and 1560 | baptism with oil and chrism (13.3.2); visitation service (13.20.1) | the yearly blessings (13.15.1); weather-ringing (13.15.5) |
| Waldeck 1583 and 1584 | — | *Kirchweih* (13.14.4); exorcism and the baptismal robe (13.4.4) |
| Halberstadt 1588 | — | church dedication and font blessing (13.14.1) |
| Thüngen 1564 | — | churching (13.5.1); weather-ringing (13.15.5) |
| Stendal 1541 | order of the Rogation procession: cross, schoolboys, priests, people (13.18.4) | — |
| Waldeck 1556 | funeral procession: sexton with cross, schoolboys, schoolmaster, pastor (13.18.4) | — |
| Havelberg 1558 | the Sunday circuit with council and congregation following (13.18.4) | — |
| Perleberg 1581 | surplices for pastor, chaplains and sexton at funerals (13.18.4) | — |
| Baden 1533 | the sacrament carried to the sick with light and bells (13.18.4) | — |
| Kronstadt 1543 | communion of the sick (13.18.4) | candles, bells and pomp (13.18.4) |
| Mecklenburg 1552 | — | banners and processional crosses (13.18.4) |
| Strasbourg 1598 | the council procession to the Minster (13.18.4) | — |

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Landtagsabschied* 1526 | leftovers kept in the sacrament house for the sick and later communicants (13.20.3) | — |
| Nuremberg *Lehrartikel* and Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1528 | — | locking up and carrying about the sacrament (13.20.3) |
| Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Rostock about 1560 | communion on Good Friday as on a Sunday (13.20.4) | Mass of the Presanctified (13.20.4) |
| Goslar (Nuremberg report) 1528, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed), Feuchtwangen 1563, Teschen 1584 | — | Easter sepulchre (13.20.4); ciborium (Teschen, 20.3) |
| Merseburg 1544, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553, Wolfstein 1574, Lüneburg 1575 | remaining elements consumed by minister or communicants (13.20.5) | reservation (13.20.3, 13.20.5) |
| Transylvanian Saxons 1547 | — | communion from hosts kept "in corners" (13.20.3); anxiety over leftovers (13.20.5) |
| Electoral Brandenburg 1540 (Holy Week) | Palm Sunday procession, Maundy Thursday foot-washing, Good Friday burial and Easter resurrection represented, Easter Vespers with baptism (13.21.3) | blessing of palms and of the fire (13.21.3) |
| Kurpfalz *Bedenken* 1546, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Anhalt 1532 | Christmas and Easter Matins toward morning; Ascension and Whitsun None (13.21.2, 13.21.6) | midnight watch; water, hosts, fire, figures and dove at Ascension and Whitsun (13.21.6) |
| Naumburg 1537, Nördlingen 1555, Hof 1592 | Christmas Matins lessons with *Liber generationis*; *Gloria, laus* on Palm Sunday; Tenebrae as an evening office (21.2–21.4) | — |
| Schweinfurt 1543, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed), Waldeck 1556 | Good Friday Matins and Passion; solemn prayers in German (13.21.4) | Easter candle, fire-blessing, font procession (Mülhausen, 21.5) |
| Luther *Formula missae* 1523, Hildesheim 1544 | Alleluia as "the perpetual voice of the church" (13.21.7) | penitential rites peculiar to Lent and Holy Week (13.21.7) |
| Regensburg [1567], Thüngen 1587, Albrechtshain 1554, Pomerania 1569, Kolberg 1586 | Athanasian Creed read, sung or preached on Trinity Sunday (13.21.7) | — |
| Niemegk 1529, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Grubenhagen 1544, Mecklenburg 1552, Lüneburg 1564 | Litany in place of the Supper when no one communes (13.22.1) | — |

| Order | Forms given (§) | Abolished, rejected or omitted (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Transylvanian Saxons 1547 | Creed with suffrages for the king, for sins and for peace in the service without communion (13.22.1) | — |
| Hof 1592 | weekday *Tagmeß* with the Litany divided over four days (13.22.1) | Litany left out at a baptism (13.22.1) |
| Dietrich 1545, Amberg 1550, Waldeck 1556, Mecklenburg 1542 | Litany after the epistle, during communion, after the sermon (13.22.2) | — |
| Calenberg 1542, Heidelberg chapter 1546, Pomerania 1569 | Rogation Litany without the saints (13.22.4) | the procession; *Sancte Petre, ora pro nobis* (13.22.4) |
| Zweibrücken 1533 and 1574 | Litany in the Christmas, Easter and Whitsun weeks (13.22.5) | — |
| Schwäbisch Hall 1543, Limpurg 1610 | Litany on Good Friday (13.22.6) | — |
| Waldeck 1556 | eleven Good Friday biddings with collects, in German (13.22.6) | *Flectamus genua*; the prayers for the pope and the pagans (13.22.6) |

## 13.24 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §13.23 and the text.

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Amberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1550 | 13, p. 286 | 13.22.2 |
| Anhalt | *Ordnung* of Nicolaus Hausmann | 1532 | 2, pp. 542–543 | 13.21.2 |
| Baden | *Kirchenordnung* | 1533 | 16, p. 510 | 13.18.4 |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1588 | 22, p. 269 | 13.4.4 |
| Brandenburg (Electorate) | *Kirchenordnung* | of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, pp. 54, 58–59, 59, 62–63, 81, 88 | 13.3.2, 13.6.4, 13.15.2, 13.17.3, 13.18.2, 13.18.4, 13.21.3 |
| Brandenburg (Electorate) | *Visitation- und Consistorialordnung* | 1573 | 3, p. 128 | 13.7.10 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach | *Landtagsabschied* | 1526 | 11, p. 91 | 13.20.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach | *Ordo ecclesiasticus* | 1592 | 11, p. 456 | 13.7.4 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach- | *Konsistorialordnung* | 1594 | 11, p. 392 | 13.4.3 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Kulmbach | | | | |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1528 | 11, pp. 135, 138 | 13.3.2, 13.20.3 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1533 | 11, pp. 174, 177, 180, 201–202, 203 | 13.3.1, 13.3.4, 13.5.1, 13.7.2, 13.9.3 |
| Braunschweig | *Kirchenordnung* | 1528 | 6/1, p. 360 | 13.4.2 |
| Brunswick | *Kirchenordnung* | 1528 | 6/1, p. 379 | 13.20.4 |
| Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel | *Klosterordnung* | 1569 | 6/1, pp. 325–326 | 13.12.10 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen | *Ordnung der confirmation oder firmung* | 1542 | 6/2, pp. 838–839, 843 | 13.6.3 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1542 | 6/2, pp. 799, 812 | 13.15.1, 13.22.4 |
| Electoral Saxony | *Constitution und artikel des geistlichen consistorii zu Wittemberg* | 1542 | 1, pp. 202, 206 | 13.8.2, 13.16.2 |
| Electoral Saxony | *Wittenbergische Reformation* | 1545 | 1, p. 211 | 13.6.1, 13.10.1 |
| Esslingen (Moderate Reformed) | *Mandat für die altgläubigen Geistlichen* | 10 August 1532 | 17/2, p. 371 | 13.19.1 |
| Gengenbach (Moderate Reformed) | *Bestallung eines Schulmeysters der Statt Gengenbach* | 1536 | 17/1, p. 483 | 13.12.3 |
| Goslar | *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat* | 30 March 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 232 | 13.20.4 |
| Grubenhagen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 6/2, p. 1033 | 13.22.1 |
| Grubenhagen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1581 | 6/2, pp. 1052, 1058 | 13.16.1, 13.16.6 |
| Halberstadt | *Instruktion für die Visitation* | 8 August 1588 | 2, p. 470 | 13.14.1 |
| Havelberg | *Abschied* | 1558 | 3, p. 232 | 13.18.4 |
| Heidelberg (Reformed) | *Bestallung eines Glöckners* | 15 May 1572 | 14, p. 457 | 13.12.2 |
| Heilbronn | *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser* | 8 December 1531 | 17/1, p. 298 | 13.12.6 |
| Henneberg | *Kirchenordnung* | of Georg Ernst, 1582 | 2, pp. 304–305 | 13.4.3 |
| Herford | *Kirchenordnung* | 1532 | 21, p. 192 | 13.7.4 |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed) | *Reformatio ecclesiarum Hassiae* | (Homberg), 1526 | 8, p. 50 | 13.14.1 |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed) | *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung* | 1539 | 8, p. 104 | 13.6.2 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1566 | 8, pp. 209, 211, 211–212 | 13.12.1, 13.19.3 |
| Hesse (Philippist) | *Agende* | 1574 | 8, pp. 454–455 | 13.10.5 |
| Hildesheim | *Christlike kerckenordeninge* | 1544 | 7/2.1, p. 853 | 13.21.7 |
| Hildesheim | *Bestallung des Organisten Severus Kroschen* | 1581 | 7/2.1, p. 901 | 13.12.3 |
| Hof | *Ordo ecclesiasticus* | 1592 | 11, pp. 439, 455, 463, 464, 467 | 13.14.3, 13.18.4, 13.21.3, 13.22.1 |
| Hohenlohe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1553 | 15, p. 72 | 13.20.5 |
| Kronstadt | *Reformationsbüchlein* | German version, 1543 | 24, p. 196 | 13.18.4 |
| Kurpfalz | *Bedenken zur Reformation der Stiftskirchen* | 1546 | 14, p. 92 | 13.21.2, 13.21.6 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1563 | 14, pp. 337, 340 | 13.3.6 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Ordnung der Ordination* | 1592 | 19/2, p. 792 | 13.10.5 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Ordnung der Einführung der Kirchendiener* | 1592 | 19/2, p. 793 | 13.11.2 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Einführung der Senioren* | 9 December 1592 | 19/2, pp. 789–790 | 13.12.1 |
| Leisnig | *Verordnung der Visitatoren für das Amt Leisnig* | 1529 | 1, p. 609 | 13.12.4 |
| Lippe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1538 | 21, p. 319 | 13.8.1 |
| Lippe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1571 | 21, p. 447 | 13.12.2 |
| Luther | *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht* | 1523, epilogue | 1, p. 20 | 13.3.1 |
| Luther | *Das taufbuchlin verdeutscht* | 1523 | 1, pp. 19–20 | 13.3.2 |
| Luther | *Formula missae et communionis* | 1523 | 1, p. 5 | 13.21.7 |
| Luther | *Das taufbuchlin verdeudscht aufs neu zu gericht* | 1526 | 1, pp. 22–23 | 13.3.3 |
| Luther | *Deudsche messe und ordnung gottis diensts* | 1526 | 1, p. 16 | 13.21.1 |
| Luther | *Traubüchlein* | 1529 | 1, p. 24 | 13.7.1 |
| Luther | *Forma ordinationis latina* | 1539 | 1, p. 28 | 13.10.2 |
| Lüneburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 6/1, pp. 557–558 | 13.12.5 |
| Lüneburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1575 | 6/1, pp. 655, 660 | 13.20.5, 13.22.2 |
| Mansfeld | *Form und weise einer visitation* | 1554 | 2, p. 192 | 13.3.8 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld | *Kirchen-Agenda* | 1580 | 2, pp. 222, 223, 234, 241–242, 242–243, 246 | 13.5.2, 13.6.5, 13.9.4, 13.16.5 |
| Marggrabowa | *Gottesdienstordnung* | 1581 | 4, p. 149 | 13.22.3 |
| Mecklenburg | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1542 | 5, p. 149 | 13.22.2 |
| Mecklenburg | *Visitations-Instruction* | 12 November 1552 | 5, p. 220 | 13.18.4 |
| Mecklenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1552 | 5, p. 202 | 13.22.1 |
| Mecklenburg | *Consistorialordnung* | 1570 | 5, pp. 245–246, 246 | 13.16.4 |
| Merseburg | *Synodalunterricht* | 1544 | 2, p. 18 | 13.20.5 |
| Merseburg | *Ordinations-Ordnung (Georg of Anhalt's draft, editor's summary)* | 1545 | 2, p. 7 | 13.10.3 |
| Micron (Reformed) | *Ordinancien* | (1554), East Frisian German edition, 1565 | 7/1, pp. 596, 597–598, 652 | 13.12.1, 13.16.7 |
| Mulhouse (Reformed) | *Eid des Schulmeisters* | 1551 | 20/2, p. 251 | 13.12.3 |
| Mülhausen (Reformed) | *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche* | [1528] | 20/2, p. 207 | 13.21.5 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1537 | 10, p. 76 | 13.15.1 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg | *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel* | 1570 | 10, pp. 138, 139, 141 | 13.12.7 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg | *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel* | 1570, "Eydt der dominae" | 10, pp. 141–142 | 13.12.8 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg (Philippist) | *Agende* | 1575 | 10, p. 150 | 13.4.4 |
| Naumburg | *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche* | 1537/1538 | 2, p. 71 | 13.21.2 |
| Nuremberg | *Die Nürnberger 23 Lehrartikel* | 1528 | 11, p. 134 | 13.20.3 |
| Nuremberg | *Agendbüchlein* | of Veit Dietrich, 1545 | 11, pp. 498, 506, 522, 528, 531–532 | 13.4.1, 13.8.4, 13.8.6, 13.9.1, 13.20.5, 13.22.2 |
| Nördlingen | *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners* | 1544 | 12, p. 315 | 13.12.6 |
| Palatinate | *Kirchenordnung* | of Ottheinrich, 1556 | 14, p. 140 | 13.17.2 |
| Palatinate (Reformed) | *Ehegerichtsordnung* | 1563 | 14, p. 327 | 13.7.10 |
| Palatinate (Reformed) | *Eid der Kirchenschaffner* | May 1577 | 19/2, p. 749 | 13.12.4 |
| Palatinate | *Verzeichnuß etlicher capitum, darauf ein jeder schulmeister … promission thun solle* | 1580 | 14, pp. 508–509 | 13.12.3 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Perleberg | *Visitations-Abschied* | 1581 | 3, p. 256 | 13.18.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543 | 13, pp. 55, 76, 77, 96–97 | 13.3.2, 13.15.1, 13.18.1, 13.20.5, 13.22.1 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | *Visitationsordnung* | 1560/1566 | 13, p. 140 | 13.20.1 |
| Pfalz-Simmern | *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg* | 1560 | 19/2, p. 658 | 13.12.9 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken | *12 Artikel "Form und Maß"* | 1533 | 18, p. 52 | 13.22.5 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken | *Form und Ordnung* | 1539 | 18, pp. 59, 61 | 13.4.1, 13.8.1 |
| Pomerania | *Kerckenordeninge* | 1569 | 4, p. 386 | 13.4.1 |
| Pomerania | *Agenda* | 1569 | 4, pp. 461–462, 466, 477 | 13.8.7, 13.21.7, 13.22.4 |
| Pomesania | *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis* | 1524 | 4, p. 29 | 13.15.1 |
| Prussia | *Visitationsabschied für Zinten* | 1575 | 4, p. 153 | 13.7.9 |
| Regensburg | *Form der Ordination oder Priesterweihe* | 1553? | 13, pp. 429, 430–431 | 13.10.4 |
| Regensburg | *Erklärung … welchen … leichpredig und leichgesänge nit mögen zugelassen werden* | 1560 | 13, p. 448 | 13.9.4 |
| Regensburg | *Ordnung für die Geistlichen zur Pestzeit* | 1562 | 13, p. 435 | 13.8.5 |
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung* | [1567] | 13, p. 478 | 13.21.7 |
| Rostock | *Conformitas ceremoniarum* | about 1560 | 5, p. 290 | 13.20.4 |
| Saalfeld | *Visitation order* | 1533 | 1, p. 654 | 13.19.2 |
| Saxe-Lauenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1585 | 5, pp. 420, 448, 449, 453 | 13.12.4, 13.16.1, 13.16.3 |
| Saxony | *Ordnung* | of Duke August, 1580 | 1, pp. 383, 425, 426, 427, 453 | 13.3.8, 13.6.7, 13.11.1, 13.15.5, 13.17.1 |
| Saxony (Albertine) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1539 | 1, pp. 266, 267–268, 270–271, 275 | 13.3.4, 13.3.7, 13.8.3, 13.9.2 |
| Saxony (Albertine) | *Gemeiner Bericht der Visitatorn* | 1540 | 1, p. 285 | 13.5.1 |
| Saxony (Albertine) | *Dresdener Ehe-Ordnung* | 1556 | 1, p. 343 | 13.7.10 |
| Saxony (Ernestine) | *Unterricht der Visitatoren* | 1528 | 1, pp. 170–171 | 13.15.5 |
| Schleswig-Holstein | *Kirchenordnung* | 1542 | 23, p. 120 | 13.11.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein | *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster* | after 1610 | 23, p. 182 | 13.12.8 |
| Schweinfurt | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543 | 11, p. 636 | 13.21.4 |
| Schwäbisch Hall | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543/1615 | 17/1, pp. 165, 166, 175 | 13.13.1, 13.14.1, 13.22.6 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Stendal | *Ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg* | 1541 | 3, p. 314 | 13.18.4 |
| Stift Verden | *Kirchenordnung* | 1606 | 7/1, p. 172 | 13.4.1 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *German baptism (early agendas)* | 1524 | 20/1, p. 124 | 13.3.2 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Agende* | 1537 | 20/1, pp. 263–264, 269 | 13.3.5, 13.7.3 |
| Strasbourg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1598 | 20/1, p. 592 | 13.18.4 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Armenordnung* | longer version, 4 August 1523 | 20/1, p. 113 | 13.12.4 |
| Teschen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1584 | 3, p. 461 | 13.20.3 |
| Thüngen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 11, p. 740 | 13.5.1 |
| Transylvanian Saxons | *Kirchenordnung* (German version) | 1547 | 24, pp. 233, 235 | 13.20.3, 13.20.5 |
| Transylvanian Saxons | *Kirchenordnung* (Latin version) | 1547 | 24, p. 223 | 13.22.1 |
| Waldeck | *Kirchenordnung* | 1556 | 9, pp. 256, 277, 278, 280 | 13.18.4, 13.21.4, 13.22.2, 13.22.6 |
| Waldeck | *Mandat zur Abschaffung von Taufexorzismus und Taufkleid* | 21 August 1584 | 9, p. 300 | 13.4.4 |
| Waldeck | *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Kirchweihfeste* | 8 August 1583 | 9, p. 299 | 13.14.4 |
| Wertheim | *Kirchenordnung* | about 1555, incorporating the instruction of 1530 | 11, p. 717 | 13.7.8 |
| Wolfstein | *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber* | 1574 | 13, p. 575 | 13.20.5 |
| Württemberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1536 | 16, pp. 111, 113 | 13.3.5, 13.8.2 |
| Württemberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1553 | 16, pp. 232–233 | 13.3.5 |
| Württemberg | *Eheordnung* | 1553 | 16, p. 279 | 13.7.6 |
| Württemberg | *Investiturordnung für evangelische Prälaten* | after 1556 | 16, pp. 321–322 | 13.11.3 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein | *Kirchenordnung* | 1588 | 10, p. 628 | 13.4.3 |

# Chapter 14. Art, Architecture, Paraments and Vestments

This chapter covers the visible furnishing of worship in the church orders of the sixteenth century printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks:

- **Art.** Which images did the orders keep, and which did they remove? How were they to be removed? What became of the crucifix, the altar panels, carved and painted figures, banners and processional crosses? Were new pictures ever ordered?
- **Architecture and furnishings.** How many altars were kept, and where did the minister stand at them? Were altars replaced by tables? What became of the lights on the altar, the sacrament house, the font, the choir screen? What do the orders say of the pulpit, pews, galleries and windows?
- **Paraments.** What cloths covered the altar, pulpit and font? What became of the corporal and pall, the cloth held under the communicants, the chalices and the stock of old vestments?
- **Seasons and colours.** Did vestments or paraments change colour with the church year? Were there more or fewer candles on feasts or in certain seasons? What became of the Lenten veil, the Easter sepulchre and paschal candle, Candlemas candles, and seasonal greenery?
- **Vestments.** Was the Mass vestment (chasuble) kept, and with or without alb? When was the cope worn, and when only the surplice? Which orders abolished all three? What were ministers to wear outside the service?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §14.1 answers each question in brief, and §14.2 sets out the scope, the search terms and the negative findings.
- §14.3 sets out the principle under which every one of these things was handled: they are *adiaphora*, things indifferent, kept or dropped for order, for the weak, or against superstition.
- §14.4 covers images and crucifixes: the Lutheran distinction between idols and histories, orderly removal, new pictures, the Reformed clearances, the crucifix, and banners and processional crosses.
- §14.5 covers the building and its furnishings: altars, the minister's position, tables in place of altars, lights, the sacrament house, the font, and the pulpit, screens, pews, galleries and windows.
- §14.6 covers paraments, linens and vessels, colours and the seasons, and the paten, host box and bread dish.
- §14.7 covers vestments: the Mass vestment kept, the cope, the vestments abolished, and the surplice.
- §14.8 covers clerical dress outside the service.
- §14.9 is a table by order, and §14.10 a concordance of every order quoted.

**Related chapters.** Several passages are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- vesting prayers before Mass: Chapter 3, §3.6.1;
- vestments and the elevation at Anhalt, and the image plays of the feasts abolished: Chapter 12, §§12.10.6, 12.10.10;
- the dedication of churches, the blessing of the font, surplices in funeral processions, and churches, altars and vessels returned to common use: Chapter 13, §§13.14, 13.15.3, 13.18, 13.19.2;
- the tonsure and the minister's dress as human ordinances, the thurifer and candle-bearer, and the deacons' and sextons' care of altar, pulpit and font: Chapter 16, §§16.3.3, 16.4.4, 16.7.2;
- bells and the organ: Chapter 9;
- the sign of the cross, kneeling and places at the altar in the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15;
- the conduct and dress required of ministers' households: Chapter 15, §15.3.3.

## 14.1 Summary of findings

**1. Everything is "indifferent", and that decides everything (§14.3).** Vestments, cloths, vessels, lights, images and altars are *adiaphora*: they "give and take nothing to faith and conscience" (Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533). The orders reach three different conclusions from that one principle:

- *Keep them* for good order, for uniformity with Wittenberg and the neighbouring churches, and for the weak: Hannover 1536, Thüngen 1564, Hildesheim 1544, Magdeburg 1583.
- *Drop them* when they foster superstition or blur the difference from the Mass: Regensburg 1554 and 1567, Transylvania 1557.
- *Forbid them* as contrary to God's word, which is the Reformed position, not an indifferent one: the Heidelberg Catechism, Kurpfalz 1565, the Casimirian mandate of 1587 (all Reformed).

**2. Images: idols out, histories in (§14.4).** The Lutheran orders remove only images that were prayed to or had lights burned before them, and keep scriptural histories as "the laity's Bible" (Brunswick 1528, Thüngen 1564, Oldenburg 1573, Regensburg 1567). Removal is to be orderly and by authority, never by the crowd:

- Strasbourg 1525 (Moderate Reformed) forbids citizens to touch anything.
- Mecklenburg 1552 nails the images to the walls.
- The Upper Palatinate in 1557 removes them by night, takes the carved figures out of mixed panels and blacks over the painted ones.

Kurland 1570 is the only order found that commissions new paintings: Old and New Testament histories, "especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement", for the native peasantry. Ulm 1531 (Moderate Reformed), the Heidelberg Catechism (Q. 98) and Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed), and two Lutheran orders that follow them here, Lichtenberg 1579 and Sponheim 1590/91, reject the "laity's books" argument and clear images and crucifixes alike. The Prussian order of 1568 answers them by name.

**3. The crucifix is the image the Lutheran orders most often name as kept (§14.4.5).** Hannover 1536, Grubenhagen 1544 (where it "shall stand in the midst of the church") and Anhalt 1562 keep it. It is carried before funerals at Freiberg 1538 and Wolfstein 1574, stands at the deathbed (Dietrich 1545) and on the Mansfeld oath table (1586). The Reformed removed it, and the Lutheran Nassau-Weilburg in 1617 stopped carrying it before corpses. Banners, poles and processional crosses went with the processions (§14.4.6).

**4. One altar; the minister before it, facing the people (§14.5.1–14.5.3).** Side altars were removed, leaving three (Wittenberg 1522) or one (Mecklenburg 1552, Upper Palatinate 1557, Kurland 1570). Colditz 1529 and Gotha 1555 order altars arranged so that the minister faces the people. The Wittenberg theologians condemned standing *behind* the table as the disorder of Karlstadt and Müntzer (Radical Reformation) (Wittenbergische Reformation 1545, Allstedt 1533). Strasbourg 1537 (Moderate Reformed) set up an altar-table facing the people, and the Reformed orders put tables in place of altars (Siegen 1581, Casimir 1587, Anhalt 1596, Simmern 1598). In Transylvania the synod of 1565 ordered altars pulled down by "turbulent men" to be restored.

**5. Two candles, no sacrament house (§14.5.4–14.5.5).** The usual Lutheran altar has two lights during the Supper (Allstedt 1533, Calenberg 1544/45, Kurland 1570). Hildesheim 1544 explains them by the night of the Last Supper. Kurpfalz 1546 (Lutheran) keeps a single lamp, and Regensburg and Anhalt 1596 (Reformed) drop the lights. No order varies the number of lights by feast or season. Where the lights vary, they vary with communion: lit when there are communicants (Marggrabowa and Sensburg 1581), and at Suhl 1562 not lit at all. The endowments for the eternal light went to the common chest (Württemberg 1536), and the blessing of Candlemas and Easter candles was abolished (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Lüneburg convents 1555). Since the Sacrament was not reserved, sacrament houses and ambries were emptied (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Schönburg 1542, Hohenlohe 1553) or removed (Pfalz-Neuburg 1560, Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Magdeburg 1583, Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed)). No order uses "tabernacle" for a furnishing.

**6. The font is moved into sight (§14.5.6).** The customary font is kept (Prussia 1525), railed and adorned (Nördlingen 1544), and moved before the choir, raised a step or two (Lüneburg 1564), or "out of the corners before the face of the church" (Bentheim 1588, Reformed). Bremen 1534 warms the water in winter. The Reformed abolish the font (Kurpfalz 1565, Casimir 1587, Simmern 1598, all Reformed).

**7. Pulpit, pews and galleries (§14.5.7).** The pulpit appears among the things to be covered and kept. The choir screen is torn down at Zweibrücken 1558 so that the nuns can be seen at sermon. Saxony 1580 complains that pews block the view of pulpit and altar and forbids new pews without leave. Hadersleben 1571 rebuilds its pews to clear the aisle and separate men and women, and Thorn and Stargard have pew orders. Schoolboys sing from the north gallery at Wittenberg 1533. Guilds that once kept altars are to keep windows instead (Neumark 1540, Salzwedel 1579).

**8. Paraments are covers, not a system (§14.6).** No order names an antependium, dossal or pulpit fall, or prescribes colours. What the orders ask for:

- clean white linen on altar and font (Anhalt 1562, Wolfenbüttel 1569);
- covers made from old vestments for altar, pulpit and font, with a pall (Henneberg 1556), and the visitors are to ask whether altar, font, pulpit and desk are "covered as is due" (Leiningen 1609);
- a corporal and pall in the sick communion (Brandenburg 1540);

- the silk cloth held under communicants by boys, deacons or honest men (Hohenlohe 1553, Regensburg 1553, Speyer 1557, Thorn 1575). The Reformed Amberg mandate of 1567 abolished it, and so later did two Lutheran orders, the Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 under the Lutheran Elector Ludwig VI and Nassau-Weilburg 1617.

Surplus vestments were sold or cut up for the hospital's bed sheets (Schmiedeberg 1528), or made into altar cloths (Sponheim 1590/91). The Reformed exchanged chalices for beakers (Siegen 1581, Casimir 1587, Zweibrücken 1595, all Reformed).

The paten was kept as an ordinary vessel (Hannover 1536) and counted in the inventories (§14.6.7). The commonest rubric puts it, with as many hosts as communicants, into the minister's hand at the Words of Institution (Livonia 1533, the Palatinate 1546, Danzig 1557, Henneberg 1582). At the sick communion it was held under the communicant's chin (Brandenburg 1540). Havelberg (1558) forbade elevating it in the chalice's stead. Hohenlohe (1596) and Nassau-Weilburg (1617), both Lutheran, stopped showing or handling it at the Verba. The Reformed melted or sold patens with the chalices (Zweibrücken 1595, Wittgenstein 1605, both Reformed) and passed the bread in a dish.

**9. Vestments: chasuble, cope, surplice (§14.7).**

- *The Mass vestment* (alb and chasuble) was kept, and in Saxony restored, for the Supper with communicants: Leisnig 1529, Allstedt 1533, Grubenhagen 1544, Calenberg 1544/45, Thüngen 1564, Wolfenbüttel 1569, Thorn 1575. Riga 1530 and Kurland 1570 made a plain surplice the norm, with cope or chasuble on feasts.
- *The cope* replaced the chasuble when there were no communicants, so that the people should not think the private Mass had returned (Brandenburg 1540, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543). Brenz allowed it to the deacon at Schwäbisch Hall in 1527, but no chasuble, "neither man's nor woman's clothing".
- *Abolished:* the dalmatic and tunicle at Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed); the "Levite and Mass vestments" at Regensburg in 1554, with a reasoned statement read from the pulpit; the Mass vestment at Sayn 1575 and Anhalt 1596 (Reformed). Transylvania 1557 wants candles and *infulae* laid aside and a white linen garment instead.
- *The surplice* is the common minimum and the vestment most often named: Prussia 1543, Hesse 1532 (Moderate Reformed), Württemberg 1535 and 1553, the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545, Regensburg 1554 and 1567, Wittgenstein 1563, Anhalt 1568. Ernestine Saxony and Coburg in 1554 limit it to the altar. The Palatine Calvinists (Reformed) and the Lutheran Sayn 1582 abolish it. Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603 introduces a black gown with sleeves, but keeps surplices where they are used.

**10. Outside the service (§14.8).** Ministers are to wear long, honest, priestly coats, not short, slashed or coloured clothes, so that they may be known as ministers (Grubenhagen 1544, the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545, Regensburg 1567, Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1603).

**11. Colours and the seasons (§14.6.6).** No order prescribes liturgical colours or a seasonal change of vestments or paraments. Coloured vestments nonetheless stayed in use. In 1578 the Fürstenberg church had a red-and-green velvet chasuble newly given by the Duke of Mecklenburg, a red velvet chasuble and red damask deacon's coats. At Sorau the boys who held the communion cloths wore red smocks and green garlands. The Lenten veiling of images is named only to be ended: Luther rejects it, Mülhausen 1528 (Reformed) drops the unveiled crucifix shown on Good Friday, and at Regensburg a covered altarpiece was removed all the same. The Lenten veil, the Easter sepulchre, the paschal candle and the image plays of the feasts were all abolished (Luther 1526, Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, Hohenlohe 1553). Leiningen-Westerburg 1566 forbids May branches and decking the church with flowers as heathen customs; only at Hof (1592) did neighbours strew grass and set up May branches for the dedication procession. There is no Advent wreath or Christmas tree.

**12. What is absent (§14.2.3).** There is no evangelical mitre or crosier, and no preaching bands, cassock, rochet, biretta or episcopal insignia. Liturgical colours are never prescribed. The orders do not mention altar rails, credence tables, altars of repose, mosaics or stained-glass programmes, and say nothing of transepts, vaults, buttresses or undercrofts.

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## 14.2 Scope, sources and method

### 14.2.1 Sources

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`: the orders themselves, the visitation articles and decrees printed with them, and, where said, the editor's introductions and notes. It covers Lutheran, Upper German and Reformed

orders alike, since the edition prints all three, and the Reformed clearances explain much of what the later Lutheran orders defend.

### 14.2.2 Searches

The corpus was searched with regular expressions for some thirty families of terms, in High and Low German and Latin spellings. Each hit was read in a window of context. The families, with the number of document-pages in which each was found, were:

- **Art:** *Bild*, *Bildnis*, *imago*, *statua* (752); *Gemälde*, *Tafel*, *Maler* (810); *Crucifix* (69); *Kreuz*, *crux* (1,873, most of them the "cross" of suffering); *Fahne*, *Banner*, *vexillum* (80); *Fenster*, *Glasfenster* (93); *Reliquien*, *Heiltum* (227).
- **Building and furnishings:** *Altar* (1,951); *Kanzel*, *Predigtstuhl* (1,266); *Taufstein*, *döpe*, *baptisterium* (562); *Lettner*, *Gitter*, *Schranken* (68); *Sakristei*, *Gerbkammer* (57); *Gestühl*, *Kirchenstuhl*, *Bänke*, *Empore*, *Borkirche* (174); *Pult*, *Lesepult* (71); *Kerze*, *Leuchter*, *Ampel*, *Lampe* (222); *Beichtstuhl* (17); *Sakramentshäuslein*, *Monstranz*, *ciborium* (222); *Kirchturm* (118); *Kirchhof*, *Gottesacker* (537).
- **Paraments and vessels:** *Altartuch*, *Corporal*, *Palla*, *Velum*, *Vorhang*, *Zwehle*, *Handtuch*, *lavabo*, *purificatorium*, *bursa* (244); *Ornat*, *Ornament*, *Zierat*, *Kleinod* (331); *Kelch*, *calix*, *Patene* (1,112).
- **Vestments:** *Chorrock*, *Chorhemd*, *superpellicium*, *Röckel*, *Rochet* (262); *Meßgewand*, *Casel*, *casula*, *planeta* (196); *Alba*, *Humerale*, *Amictus*, *Stola*, *Manipel*, *Cingulum* (134); *Chorkappe*, *Chormantel*, *cappa*, *pluviale* (188); *Infel*, *Mitra*, *Bischofsstab*, *Krummstab*, *baculus* (110); *Dalmatik*, *Levitenrock*, *tunicella* (27); *Priesterkleid*, *Kirchenkleid*, *lange Röcke*, *Schaube*, *Talar*, *Barett* (155).

Further searches were made for the English terms of the request that have German equivalents: mosaic, narthex (*Vorhalle*, *Vorkirche*), transept (*Querschiff*), vault (*Gewölbe*), buttress, undercroft (*Krypta*, *Gruft*), credence (*Kredenz*), antependium, dossal, altar rail and kneeling bench (*Altargitter*, *Kniebank*), liturgical colours, preaching bands (*Beffchen*, *Kragen*), mitre and crosier.

A second pass searched for reservation and the seasons: tabernacle (*Tabernakel*), ambry (*armarium*, *Almer*, *Wandschrank*, *Sakramentsnische*); colour words (*rot*, *grün*, *schwarz*, *violett*, *Farbe*) near vestments and cloths; the Lenten veil (*Hungertuch*, *Fastentuch*), the covering or veiling of images, crosses and altars (*decken*, *verdecken*, *verhüllen*, *velare*, *tegere*); the Easter sepulchre (*heiliges Grab*) and paschal candle (*Osterkerze*, *Osterstock*); Candlemas candles (*Lichtmeß*, *Kerzenweihe*); *Tenebrae* and *Finstermette*; the eternal light (*ewiges Licht*); greenery and flowers (*Maien*, *Kirchen blümen*, *Gras streuen*, *Kranz*, *Tannenbaum*, *Christbaum*, *Krippe*); and lights named together with feasts, Sundays and weekdays.

### 14.2.3 What was not found

The searches came back empty, or with only incidental hits, for most of the architectural and episcopal vocabulary of the request:

- **Architecture.** No order regulates the nave, transept, vault, buttress, arch, steeple or undercroft. *Vorkirche* occurs, but in the sense of a gallery, where the boys are not to be suffered during the catechism (Ysenburg-Birstein 1588), or as one item in a list of parts to be kept in repair. *Querschiff* occurs once, in an editor's note. Towers, roofs, windows and churchyard walls appear only as fabric to be maintained, and bells are treated in Chapter 9.
- **Art.** No order mentions mosaics, or regulates what stained glass may show. Statues appear only as "carved images" to be removed or left. No order commissions a sculpture. The only new pictures ordered are Kurland's (§14.4.3).
- **Furnishings.** There is no altar rail, no credence table and no altar of repose. *Kredenz* occurs only as a letter of credence. Kneeling benches for communicants appear at Hohenlohe (§14.6.3) and, by the editor's report, at Hoya 1581. The rood screen appears only as the *Gitter* or *Schranken* to be removed (§14.5.7).
- **Paraments.** No antependium, frontal, superfrontal, dossal, reredos, runner, pulpit fall or lectern fall is named; the orders speak only of covers (*Decken*) for altar, pulpit, font and desk (§14.6.1). The corporal and pall appear once (§14.6.2). No order regulates the purificator, burse, chalice veil or lavabo towel. Font towels appear once (§14.5.6).
- **Seasons.** No order prescribes liturgical colours or seasonal changes; the colour sequence appears only in the editor's notes, and coloured vestments only in an inventory and a later report (§14.6.6). No order varies the number of candles by feast or season. *Tabernakel* never names a furnishing. No order prescribes veiling images or crosses in Lent or Passiontide; the veiling is mentioned only to be abolished (§14.6.6). There is no Advent wreath, Christmas tree, Easter garden or crib set up in church, and the Tenebrae hearse is never mentioned.
- **Vestments.** No order provides an evangelical mitre or crosier. The *Hirtenstab* occurs only as a metaphor for the preaching office, and Transylvanian *infulae* most likely means chasubles (§14.7.3). There are no preaching bands, cassock,

cotta, cassock-alb, rochet, biretta, zucchetto, galero, humeral veil, pallium, rationale, gloves, tippet or hood. The amice and cincture are never named. The stole and maniple appear only to be left free (Hildesheim 1544) or dropped (Regensburg 1567), and the dalmatic and tunicle only to be forbidden (Hesse 1526, Moderate Reformed; Regensburg 1554). The black gown appears once, in 1603 (§14.7.4).

#### 14.2.4 Method

Quoted passages were pulled from the database in full and checked as described in the conventions. Each page was checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. The most important corrections:

- the Bremen order is the *Kirchenordnung* of 1534, not the poor-chest order of 1525;
- the Mansfeld oath form belongs with the consistorial order of 1586;
- the Prussian surplice decree is the *Befehl* of 1 February 1543, and the image passage is from the *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien* of 1568;
- the Sponheim passages are from the Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim (1590/91 and 1607), not Zweibrücken;
- the Palatine passage on images, altars and fonts is the Elector's *Befehl an die Amtleute* of 3 October 1565, printed after the Heidelberg Catechism.

The chapter quotes nearly a hundred passages from some eighty orders. It does not claim to list every mention of an altar or chalice, which number in the thousands, but every order found that says something distinctive on the questions asked is quoted or cited.

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## 14.3 Things indifferent

#### 14.3.1 The principle

**Brandenburg-Nürnberg 1533.** Every order that deals with these matters begins from the same place: vestments, cloths, vessels and lights are outward things, neither commanded nor forbidden by God. The Brandenburg-Nürnberg order of 1533 says it in a sentence. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 183):

> Die andern zusetz eußerlicher, leiblicher ding als meßgewand, altardeck, silbrein und güldein gefeß, lichter etc. sein aller ding frei, geben und nemen dem glauben und gewissen nichts.

The other additions of outward, bodily things, as Mass vestment, altar covering, silver and golden vessels, lights, etc., are altogether free; they give and take nothing to faith and conscience.

**Hannover 1536.** Freedom did not mean abolition. The Hannover order lists what it keeps "in the freedom of the Spirit", for good order and for the weak: the priest's vestment at the altar, the customary vessels, lights on the altar, the crucifix and honest images, the font and the altar. **Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1009):

> Aus der ursach wöllen wir auch umb guter ordnung willen und allen schwachen zu dienst noch etliche gebreuchliche cerimonien behalten, doch in der freiheit des Geistes, als gewönliche priesterkleidung bey dem altar, gewönliche gefes, so zu handlung der heiligen sacrament bisher sind gebraucht worden, liechter auf dem altar, crucifix und ehrliche bildnis, dadurch kein abgötterey getrieben wird, taufstein, altar, christliche gesenge, deudsch und latin, nach gelegenheit der zeit

For that cause will we also, for good order's sake and for the service of all the weak, still keep certain customary ceremonies, yet in the freedom of the Spirit: as the customary priestly clothing at the altar, the customary vessels which have been used hitherto for the handling of the holy sacraments, lights upon the altar, crucifix and honest images whereby no idolatry is practised, font, altar, Christian songs, German and Latin, according to the occasion of the time.

#### 14.3.2 Keep what each church has

**Magdeburg 1583.** The rule most often given to visitors was to leave each church as it was. The Magdeburg instruction of 1583 lets Mass vestments, surplices, lights, altar cloths and the language of singing stand "as each church hath it in use", so that no unrest arise from changing, abolishing or setting up. Superstitious things are another matter: idolatrous images, the sacrament house and the monstrance are to go. **Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583** (Sehling 2, p. 424):

> messgewand, chorröck, lichter ufs altar, altartucher, singen lateinisch oder teutsch soll man pleiben lassen, zu halten oder nicht, wie es ein jede kirche im gebrauch ist, das hiermit durch enderung, abthuung oder aufrichtung kein unruhe in kirchen angerichtet werde nach dem spruch Christi: Regnum dei non venit cum observatione. Aber ergerliche abergleubige ceremonien, ob die wol alt weren, soll man abschaffen, als abgottische bilder, da etwas ein cultus were angewandt worden, sacrament heuselein, monstranz

Mass vestment, surplices, lights upon the altar, altar cloths, singing in Latin or in German, one shall let remain, to keep or not, as each church hath it in use, that hereby through changing, putting away or setting up no unrest be stirred up in churches, according to the saying of Christ: *Regnum Dei non venit cum observatione*. But offensive, superstitious ceremonies, though they were old, shall be abolished, as idolatrous images to which some worship hath been applied, sacrament houses, monstrance.

#### 14.3.3 Kept for peace and for the weak

**Thüngen 1564.** The Franconian lordship of Thüngen keeps Mass vestment and burning candles because they were in use "in Dr Martin's lifetime" at Wittenberg, in Meissen, Brandenburg and the chief imperial cities, and still are. The motive is peace and the weak, not any holiness in the things. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, pp. 736–737):

> 4. Vom meßgewand und brennenden lichten oder kerzen. Dieweil das meßgewand, wie mans nennet, und die brennenden kerzen bei d. Martini leben gebräuchlich gewest in der wittenbergischen, meichsnischen, brandenburgischen und der furnembsten reichsstedten kirchen, auch in solchen bis auf diesen tag beides gehalten wird und bei uns des mehrerteils solche beide stücke ungeendert gelassen, wollen wir ferner um friedens und einigkeit willen und von wegen der schwachen in unsern kirchen also behalten - nicht in meinung, das dadurch dem hochwürdigen sacrament sondere wirdigkeit oder heiligkeit widerfahre oder das es notwendig also sein müsse oder auch das es den papisten zu gefallen oder sonst jemand zum verdrieß geschehe, sondern allein um friedens willen und zu verhütung der schwachen ergernis.

4. Of the Mass vestment and burning lights or candles. Forasmuch as the Mass vestment, as men call it, and the burning candles were in use in Dr Martin's lifetime in the churches of Wittenberg, of Meissen, of Brandenburg and of the chiefest imperial cities, and both are kept in the same unto this day, and with us for the most part both these pieces have been left unchanged, we will further keep them so in our churches for peace and unity's sake and because of the weak: not in the meaning that thereby any special worthiness or holiness befall the most worthy sacrament, or that it must needs be so, or yet that it be done to please the papists or to vex any other, but only for peace's sake and to prevent the offence of the weak.

**Hildesheim 1544.** The Hildesheim order keeps vestments and lights at the Sacrament on holy days "not as needful before God, but only as seemly before men", and only until all the evangelical churches agree to drop them. The stole and maniple it leaves to the preachers' freedom. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

> Dewile nu vele stede unde lande, de dat evangelion angenomen hebben, solcke kleder unde lichte allene des hilligen dages by dem sacramente noch beholden, nicht nödtlick vor Godde, sunder ailene eerlick vor den minschen, so wille wy se ock beholden, so lange, dat se alle andere, de dat evangelion hebben angenomen, eindrechtichlick affdon. Alse denne so wille wy ock nicht sünderlick syn, willen unse predicanten nicht gebruken der stolen unde manipelen, dar frage wy nichtes na, dat schal öhne fry syn ut dersülven christliken fryheit, alse gesecht.

Now whereas many cities and lands which have received the gospel still keep such clothes and lights at the sacrament on the holy day only, not as needful before God but only as seemly before men, so will we also keep them, so long as until all others which have received the gospel put them away with one accord. Then will we also not be singular. If our preachers will not use the stoles and maniples, we ask nothing after that; it shall be free to them out of the same Christian liberty, as is said.

**Hesse 1526** (Moderate Reformed). Even the Homberg synod of 1526, which forbade new purchases of vestments (§14.7.3), commended a minimum "that all things be done decently": the minister should at least wear a surplice, candles should be lit, and the chalice should be seemly. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 45):

> Servetur in ea ritus, quem servus Dei Martinus Lutherus ultimo germanice conscripsit, et ut iuxta Paulum cuncta decentius fiant, laudamus si in eius ministerio ad minus induatur superpellicium, incendantur cerei, et decens calix habeatur.

Let there be kept therein the rite which the servant of God Martin Luther last wrote in German; and that, according to Paul, all things be done the more decently, we commend it if in its ministry at the least a surplice be put on, candles be lighted, and a seemly chalice be had.

#### 14.3.4 The limit

The same principle could cut the other way. Where a thing was used superstitiously, or where keeping it seemed to make no difference between the evangelical service and the Mass, it ceased to be indifferent and was to go. The Regensburg reasons of 1554 for dropping the Mass vestment (§14.7.3) and the Transylvanian synod of 1557 on candles and vestments (§14.7.3) both argue in this way. The Reformed orders went further and treated images, altars and fonts as forbidden in themselves (§§14.4.4, 14.5.3).

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## 14.4 Images and crucifixes

#### 14.4.1 Idols and histories

**Brunswick 1528.** The Lutheran orders do not condemn images as such. They condemn worship given to them. Bugenhagen's Brunswick order says that good books have been written showing it is not wrong to have images, especially those in which histories may be seen. The council has removed only those images before which people prayed and set lights; the rest stay, unless they too become objects of worship. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung*, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 445):

> Van den bilden synt gude böke gescreven, dat id nicht unrecht edder unchristlick sy, bilden to hebben, besundergen dar me inne mach sehn historien unde geschefte. Wy bekennen frilick, dat wy in unsen kerken vele lögenbilden unde vele unnutte klotze hebben. Doch dat wy nicht mögen bildenstormere syn unde andere lüde, bekande edder frömede, sulks nicht vor ergerlick ansehn, hebbe wy alleyne wechgedän mit ordentliker gewalt unde overicheit de bilden, by unde vor welken sonderich anbedent unde afgoderye unde sonderge ere mit lichten unde luchteren angerichtet wärd. De anderen alle, de nicht hinderlick synt in der kerken, late wy stan

Of images good books have been written, that it is not wrong nor unchristian to have images, especially those wherein one may see histories and deeds. We confess freely that we have in our churches many lying images and many unprofitable blocks. Yet, that we may not be image-stormers, and that other folk, known or strangers, may not look upon such as offensive, we have put away by ordinary power and authority only those images by and before which special worship and idolatry and special honour with lights and candlesticks was set up. All the others, which are no hindrance in the church, we let stand.

**Pomesania 1525.** The bishop of Pomesania's theses put the rule at its simplest: images are not to be prayed to, and no light is to be lit before them. **Pomesania, *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis*, 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 29):

> 16. Die bilder in häusern und kirchen soll man nicht anbeten, denselben auch kein licht anstecken.

16. The images in houses and churches one shall not pray to, nor light any light unto them.

**The laity's Bible.** The positive case came from Gregory the Great: pictures are the books of the unlettered. Thüngen 1564 removes idolatrous images "not agreeable to holy Scripture" and keeps those taken from both Testaments as "the laity's Bible and books"; pastors and sextons are to watch that no one, "especially the old women", misuse them for idolatry or sorcery. **Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 11, p. 739):

> 14. Von bildern und gemälden. Die abgöttischen bilde, so der heiligen schrift ungemeß, soll man, wie rechten christen und Gottes kinder eignet und gebüret, gar hinwegtun. Die anderen, so aus heiliger schrift alten und neuen testament genommen und den leuten zu erinnerung warhaftiger historien, zu christlicher lehr und exempel vieler löblicher und Gott wohlgefälliger tugenden dinstlich sind, die lassen wir bleiben und nach dem spruck Gregorii der laien bibel und bücher sein. Jedoch sollen die pfarhern und kirchner gute achtung darauf geben, das nicht jemand (wie leider zu vil geschieht, insonderheit von den alten weibern) solcher leidlicher und in Gottes wort gegründeter bilder entweder zu abgötterei oder zauberei mißbrauche.

14. Of images and paintings. The idolatrous images which are not agreeable to holy Scripture shall one put away altogether, as becometh and behoveth right Christians and God's children. The others, which are taken out of holy Scripture, Old and

> New Testament, and serve the people for remembrance of true histories, for Christian doctrine and for example of many laudable virtues well-pleasing to God, those we let remain, and be, according to the saying of Gregory, the laity's Bible and books. Yet shall the pastors and sextons take good heed thereto, that no one (as alas happeneth too much, especially of the old women) misuse such tolerable images, grounded in God's word, either for idolatry or for sorcery.

**Oldenburg 1573.** The Oldenburg order answers those who say "the images in the churches are mere idolatry" with the same distinction, and quotes Gregory in Latin: *Quod legentibus est scriptura, hoc idiotis praestat pictura*. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1083):

> Was aber historien sind, die in heiliger schrift geschrieben stehen, von den patriarchen, aposteln und von dem Herrn Christo und seinen wunderzeichen, auch leiden, kreuzigung, sterben, auferstehen, die in bilder gefasset sind, kan man nicht allein mit guten gewissen, sondern auch mit grossem nutz in den kirchen und heusern haben zur erinnerung der grossen woltaten Gottes und zu danksagung für dieselbigen.

But what are histories written in holy Scripture, of the patriarchs, of the apostles, and of the Lord Christ and his miracles, also his suffering, crucifying, dying, rising again, which are set forth in images, those may one have not only with good conscience but also with great profit in the churches and houses, for remembrance of the great benefits of God and for thanksgiving for the same.

**Regensburg 1567.** Regensburg, which had dropped the Mass vestment (§14.7.3), still took a middle way with images, as with the organ, figural music and Latin song: neither abolishing them altogether nor making too much of them. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

> Mit den bildnissen (gleich wie auch mit andern mehr dingen, als orgeln schlagen, figural und lateinischen gesang) halten wir (den verstand unser christlichen freiheit gleicherweis darin anzuzeigen) dis mittel, das wir sie nit allerding abtun noch zuviel damit machen; machen auch die unterscheid deren bildnis und gemelde, so gewisse gute historien der schrift haben und nit zu abgötterei oder aberglauben gebraucht werden, auch sonst gute, nüzliche erinnerung geben mögen, gegen den andern vielfältigen, bäpstischen, lugenhaften, abgöttischen, unnützen bilden und gemelden.

With the images (even as also with more other things, as playing the organ, figural and Latin song) we hold (to show therein likewise the understanding of our Christian liberty) this mean: that we neither put them away altogether nor make too much of them; we make also the difference between those images and paintings which have certain good histories of Scripture and are not used for idolatry or superstition, and may otherwise give good, profitable remembrance, and the other manifold, popish, lying, idolatrous, unprofitable images and paintings.

The order goes on to say that the costly stone image of Mary and many wax figures of men and women, life-size, had already been removed "as Hezekiah did to the brazen serpent".

**Gotha 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 569) likewise forbids "the idolatrous popish images which are not agreeable to biblical history". **Schweinfurt 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 630) follows Luther: where preachers lead the people from idolatry to Christ, "the images are already stormed and put away, so that no one regards them much"; images whose histories are uncertain and lying are to be removed by an ordinary magistrate. **Luther's *Deutsche Messe*** (Sehling 1, p. 16) wants Holy Week to be like other weeks, without "the hunger cloth, palm-shooting, covering of images and whatever more of the juggling-work there is".

#### 14.4.2 Orderly removal

**Strasbourg 1525** (Moderate Reformed). The orders insist that images be removed by authority, not by the people. The Strasbourg council's mandate of March 1525 forbids every citizen to take down anything, "small or great, in church or in the street", of images, altars, panels, iron or stone work, on pain of severe punishment; whoever has a grievance is to bring it to the council. **Strasbourg, *Mandat über Bilder und Altäre*, 18 March 1525** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 166):

> Unnser herren rete unnd XXI londt gebietten allen unnd yeden iren burgern, geistlichen unnd weltlichen, das sie eygens gewalts unnd von inen selbs sampt oder sunder nichts hinweg thun oder abbrechen sollen, es sy clein oder groß, inn kyrchen oder uff der gassen, von byldern, altarn, daffeln, ysern oder steynen werck, gar nichts ußgenommen

Our lords the councillors and the Twenty-One command all and each of their burghers, spiritual and temporal, that they shall not of their own power and of themselves, together or severally, put away or break down anything, be it small or great, in

churches or in the street, of images, altars, panels, iron or stone work, nothing at all excepted.

**Mecklenburg 1552.** The Mecklenburg visitors were to break down all altars but the high altar, use the stones for the church, nail the images to the walls, and take away offensive images and the ciboria. **Mecklenburg, *Visitations-Instruction*, 12 November 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 220):

> sollen die visitatorn vorordenen und bevel thuen, alle die altare, so uber dem hohen altar vorhanden, abzubrechen, die steine zu der kirchen zu gebrauchen und die bilde in den kirchen mit nageln an den wenden anzuschlagen, schedliche und ergerliche bilde, und die ciboria hinweg zu thuen.

the visitors shall ordain and give command to break down all the altars that are present over and above the high altar, to use the stones for the church, and to nail the images in the churches to the walls with nails, [and] to put away harmful and offensive images, and the ciboria.

**Upper Palatinate 1557.** The Upper Palatinate instruction orders idolatrous images removed by night, "without special tumult and clatter", by the officials. Where idolatrous figures stand on one panel with biblical histories, the carved figures are to be taken out and the painted ones blacked over. **Upper Palatinate, *Visitationsinstruktion*, 1557** (Sehling 13, p. 297):

> Doe auch abgottische pilder neben biblischen historien an einer tafel beisammen, sollen die ergerlichen geschnitzten pilder herausgetan und die gemalten mit schwarzer farben vermalt und verstrichen werden.

Where also idolatrous images are together with biblical histories on one panel, the offensive carved images shall be taken out, and the painted ones painted over and smeared with black colour.

**Grubenhagen 1544.** The Grubenhagen order clears everything except the crucifix, which "shall stand and remain in the midst of the church", and the Christian panels over the altars. Side altars, idolatrous panels, candlesticks, banners, poles and screens are to be removed, sold, destroyed or locked away. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1034):

> XV. Von den bildern in der kirchen. Alle gotzen und bilder, ausgenomen die biltniß des crucifixs unsers Hern Jesu Chr[ist]i, welchs soll mitten in der kirchen sthan und bleiben, sampt den christlichen tafeln uber den altarn, die andern sollen von stunden an sampt den winkelaltarn, abgottischen taffeln, leuchtern, fhanen, stangen, schranken und andere papistenstiftung abgethan und hinweggerumet, verkofft, vernichtiget oder verschlossen werden, darmit hinfürder davor keiner seine abgotterey und heucheley dreiben moge.

XV. Of the images in the church. All idols and images, excepting the image of the crucifix of our Lord Jesus Christ, which shall stand and remain in the midst of the church, together with the Christian panels over the altars: the others shall forthwith, together with the corner altars, idolatrous panels, candlesticks, banners, poles, screens and other popish foundations, be put away and cleared out, sold, destroyed or locked up, so that henceforth no one may practise his idolatry and hypocrisy before them.

**Hermannstadt 1557.** The Transylvanian Saxon synod of 1557 asks that "fabulous images and similar pictures" set up for worship be removed and sacred histories kept. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1557** (Sehling 24, p. 262):

> Cum in templis passim et ubique fabulosae imagines et similes picturae habeantur, quae ad cultum sunt praestitutae contra manifestum verbum Dei in veteri et novo testamento praescriptum, omnino, ut tollantur, necessum est, historiae vero sacrae et similes, quae docent et commonefaciunt de re gravi et seria, retineantur.

Seeing that in the churches here and everywhere fabulous images and like paintings are had, which are set up for worship against the manifest word of God prescribed in the Old and New Testament, it is altogether needful that they be taken away; but let sacred histories and the like, which teach and put in remembrance of a grave and serious matter, be retained.

#### 14.4.3 New pictures

**Kurland 1570.** One order goes beyond tolerating old pictures and orders new ones. In Kurland the surplus altars and idolatrous images are to be cleared away, and in their place "other glorious histories out of the Old and New Testament, especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement", are to be painted "for the best of the poor non-Germans", that is, the native peasantry. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 98):

> Unsere kirchen sollen nebenst den kirchhöfen reinlich, ehrlich und zierlich zugerüstet sein und gebürlicher weise, wie in der reformation angezeigt, gehalten werden, und in den kirchen nicht mehr als ein altar, dafür das hochwirdige sacrament verreichet sein mus, die andern, so noch vorhanden, sollen weg gereumt und mit allen abgöttischen bilden abgethan, und dafür andere herliche historien aus dem alten und neuen testamente, sonderlich von der auferstehung und von dem jüngsten gericht, den armen undeutschen zum besten gemalet und christlich verordnet werden.

Our churches, together with the churchyards, shall be furnished cleanly, honestly and comely, and be kept in due manner, as is shown in the reformation; and in the churches [there shall be] not more than one altar, before which the most worthy sacrament must be ministered; the others, which are yet present, shall be cleared away and put away with all idolatrous images, and in their stead other glorious histories out of the Old and New Testament, especially of the resurrection and of the Last Judgement, shall be painted and ordained in Christian wise, for the best of the poor non-Germans.

#### 14.4.4 The Reformed clearances

**Ulm 1531** (Moderate Reformed). The Upper German and Reformed orders made no distinction between idols and histories. Ulm, under Bucer's hand, orders "such worshipped images" removed from all churches as soon as the people have been taught. **Ulm, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 145):

> So wöllen wir, das sölche verehrte bilder auß allen kirchen und anndern ortten, so bald das volck durchs wort etwas der warheyt bericht würdt, durch yedes orts amptleut, denen wir des bevelch thon wöllen, hingethon werden

So will we that such worshipped images be put away out of all churches and other places, so soon as the people is somewhat informed of the truth through the word, by the officials of each place, to whom we will give command thereof.

**The Heidelberg Catechism.** The Palatine catechism of 1563 (Reformed) refuses Gregory's argument outright. **Kurpfalz, *Heidelberger Katechismus*, Question 98, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 362):

> [98.] Frag. Mögen aber nicht die bilder als der leyen bücher in den kirchen geduldet werden? Antwort. Nein, denn wir nicht sollen weiser sein denn Gott, welcher seine christenheyt nicht durch stumme götzen, sonder durch die lebendige predig seines worts wil underwiesen haben.

[98.] Question. But may not images be suffered in the churches as the laity's books? Answer. No; for we should not be wiser than God, who will not have his Christendom taught by dumb idols, but by the living preaching of his word.

**Kurpfalz 1565** (Reformed). Two years later Frederick III ordered his officials to clear what remained: altars, Mount of Olives groups, crucifixes in church, in the street and before the church, sacrament houses, fonts and holy-water stoups. **Kurpfalz, *Befehl an die Amtleute*, 3 October 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 429):

> so befinden wir noch teglich, das noch hien und wieder viel abgötterey uberig plieben, als nemlich altarien, ölberg, gotzenwerg, crucifix in der kirchen und uf den strassen, auch vor den kirchen, item sacramentheuslin, thaufstein, weichkessel und dergleichen götzenwergk mehr.

so we find still daily that yet here and there much idolatry is remaining, as namely altars, Mounts of Olives, idol-work, crucifixes in the church and on the streets, also before the churches, item sacrament houses, fonts, holy-water stoups, and more such idol-work.

The Reformed clearances that followed are quoted in §14.5.3: Nassau-Dillenburg's Siegen mandate of 1581 (images, panels, organs, altars and chalices), the Casimirian mandate of 1587 and Simmern 1598. Two Lutheran orders went the same way. The Sponheim *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung* of 1590/91 (Sehling 18, p. 653) orders "crucifix and other images which are still present" taken away, and the Lichtenberg instruction of 1579, in Lutheran Pfalz-Zweibrücken, does the same for crucifixes. **Lichtenberg, *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer*, 1579** (Sehling 18, p. 379):

> 17. ) Sollen auch die abgöttische Bilder, Crucifix, wo deren noch vorhandenn, vermög der visitation bevelch allenthalb mit Bescheidenheit hinweg geschafft werdenn.

17.) Shall also the idolatrous images, crucifixes, where such are still present, according to the command of the visitation, be everywhere put away with discretion.

**The Lutheran reply.** The Prussian order of 1568 answers the "wretched Calvinists and enthusiasts", who think a man cannot be evangelical unless he storms all paintings and tears down all images. **Prussia, *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 73):

> Künden es derhalben auch mit den leidigen Calvinisten und schwermern nicht halten, welche sich dünken lassen, man künde nicht evangelisch sein, wenn man nicht alle gemelde stürmet, alle bilder darnieder reisst, alle ceremonien abthut, und grob, unbescheiden, ohne zucht und ordnung alles lest durcheinander gehen wie das unvernünftige vieh.

We can therefore also not hold with the wretched Calvinists and enthusiasts, which let themselves think that one cannot be evangelical unless one storm all paintings, tear down all images, put away all ceremonies, and let all things go rudely, indiscreetly, without discipline and order, one through another, like the unreasoning beast.

#### 14.4.5 The crucifix

**Kept and honoured.** Hannover 1536 (§14.3.1) and Grubenhagen 1544 (§14.4.2) keep the crucifix by name. The Anhalt visitors of 1562 ordered pastors and churchwardens to keep altar and font clean, adorned with white linen cloths or tapestries, and to hold the Mass vestment and the crucifix "as a remembrance of the suffering of Christ" in comely state and honour. **Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande*, 22 July 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 562):

> Zum sechsten, haben wir auch allen pfarherrn und vorstehender bevohlen, das sie iren altar und tauf stetlich rein halden mit weissen leinen tuchern ader tapeten zieren, ir gemess gewand und was sonst zum gebrauch des heiligen mahls Christi gehort, desgleichen auch das crucifix, als ein erinnerung des leidens Christi, vor uns zur seligkeit geschehen, im zierlichen wesen und ehren halten sollen.

Sixthly, we have also commanded all pastors and wardens that they keep their altar and font continually clean, adorn [them] with white linen cloths or tapestries, [and] hold their Mass vestment and whatever else belongeth to the use of the holy supper of Christ, and likewise also the crucifix, as a remembrance of the suffering of Christ done for us unto salvation, in comely state and in honour.

**At funerals.** The Freiberg visitation of 1538 orders a crucifix carried before every funeral, "especially to the honour of the high and comforting article of the resurrection of the dead". **Freiberg, *Visitation Verordnung und Artikel*, 1538** (Sehling 1, p. 468):

> 16. Das man auch hinfurt in alleweg zum begrebnus ein crucifix vortrage, sonderlich dem hohen und trostlichen artikel der auferstehung der toten zu eren.

16. That one henceforth in every case carry a crucifix before at burial, especially to the honour of the high and comforting article of the resurrection of the dead.

Wolfstein 1574 permits it as a witness "on whom the Christians die". **Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber*, 1574** (Sehling 13, p. 586):

> Ein crucifix aber vorher zu tragen zum zeugnus, auf wen die christen sterben, nemlich auf den gecreuzigten Herrn Jesum Christum, das soll unverboten sein.

But to carry a crucifix before, for a witness on whom the Christians die, namely on the crucified Lord Jesus Christ, that shall be unforbidden.

The Nassau-Weilburg points of 1617, a Lutheran order, abolish the custom. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617** (Sehling 10, p. 353):

> 2. Wo daß crucifix bißhero den leychen vorgetragen worden, soll es, wie in andern unsern graveunndt herrschafften mehrentheilß lengst gefallen undt verplieben, auch abgestellet werden.

2. Where the crucifix hath hitherto been carried before the corpses, it shall also be put down, as in our other counties and lordships for the most part it hath long since fallen and remained [fallen].

**At the deathbed.** Veit Dietrich's Nuremberg *Agendbüchlein* allows a crucifix at the bedside of the dying but points beyond it. **Nuremberg, *Agendbüchlein Veit Dietrichs*, 1545** (Sehling 11, p. 522):

> Das man ein crucifix bei den sterbenden hat, ist an im selb nit bös. Aber wer den trost im wort hat, der hat das best crucifix, welchs nit allein die augen ansehen, sonder die ohren fassen und das herz in sich bilden kan

That one have a crucifix by the dying is not evil in itself. But whoso hath the comfort in the word, he hath the best crucifix, which not only the eyes can look upon, but the ears can grasp and the heart can image within itself.

**On the oath table.** In the Mansfeld consistory, oaths were sworn at a table covered with a black velvet pall bearing a white cross, with two great brass candlesticks and burning wax candles, a crucifix and the Bible. **Mansfeld, *Form und weise … mit den öffentlichen eidesleistungen*, appended to the consistorial order, 1586** (Sehling 2, p. 214):

> 7. Wird der tisch gedecket mit einen schwarzen sambten leichtuch, welches ein weiss creuze hat. 8. Hinten auf den tische gegen dem hofefenster werden gesetzt zwene grosse messingene kirchenleuchter mit zweien brennenten wachs kerzen, ferner auf dem tisch ein crucifix und die bibel dabei gelegt.

7. The table is covered with a black velvet pall, which hath a white cross. 8. At the back upon the table, toward the court window, are set two great brass church candlesticks with two burning wax candles; further, upon the table a crucifix, and the Bible laid by it.

The form explains on the next page that the crucifix signifies Christ with the whole treasure of his merit, and the Bible all the promises of the gospel.

#### 14.4.6 Banners, processional crosses and image plays

Banners (*Fahnen*), poles and processional crosses went with the processions they served. The Saalfeld visitors of 1533 ordered the council to remove "all screens, candles, banners, idolatrous images and hindrances, and above all the altars save one" (Sehling 1, p. 654). Mecklenburg 1552 orders "the banners and crosses which one was wont to carry about in the papacy" taken out of the churches (Sehling 5, p. 220), and Grubenhagen 1544 lists "banners, poles" among the things to be removed (§14.4.2). Brunswick 1528 counts "lights, banners" among the needless splendour of baptism (Sehling 6/1, p. 356).

The image plays of the great feasts went with them. Hohenlohe 1553 abolishes the carrying about of the image of the risen Christ at Easter, its drawing up on Ascension Day, the letting down of the dove at Pentecost and the rocking of the Christ-child at Christmas (Sehling 15, p. 77; see Chapter 12, §12.10.10).

The rites of the feasts in which the image plays stood are treated in Chapter 13, §13.21.

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### 14.5 The building and its furnishings

#### 14.5.1 How many altars

**Wittenberg 1522.** The side altars served private Masses, and they went with them. The Wittenberg order of January 1522 is the earliest: images and altars are to be removed to avoid idolatry, "for three altars without images are enough". **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522** (Sehling 1, p. 697):

> Item die bild und altarien in der kirchen söllen auch abgethon werden, damit abgötterei zu vermeiden, dann drei altaria on bild genug seind

Item, the images and altars in the church shall also be put away, that idolatry may be avoided, for three altars without images are enough.

**One altar.** Later orders keep a single altar for the Supper. Kurland 1570 allows "not more than one altar" (§14.4.3), and its sexton prepares only that altar, "since no other or more altars are to be used, much less to be permitted after popish custom" (Sehling 5, p. 87). Mecklenburg 1552 keeps the high altar alone (§14.4.2), and the Upper Palatinate instruction of 1557 orders "all altars save one, whereon one holdeth the Lord's Supper" taken away (Sehling 13, p. 297). Saalfeld 1533 does the same (Sehling 1, p. 654).

**Württemberg 1536.** Where a church still had several altars, Württemberg let the minister choose the most convenient. **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 107):

> ein solchen altar zu dem Nachtmal erwölen, der am allergelegnesten sein mag, da man am kommelichsten zu und von gehn und alle ding am deutlichsten hören möge, welcher altar auch mit brot und wein nach notturfft zugericht sein soll

choose such an altar for the Supper as may be the most convenient of all, where one may go to and from most commodiously and hear all things most plainly; which altar also shall be furnished with bread and wine as need requireth.

**Hermannstadt 1565.** In Transylvania the danger ran the other way. The synod of 1565 forbids the altars to be destroyed, and where "turbulent men" have pulled them down, pastors are to see them restored without tumult. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalartikel*, 1565** (Sehling 24, p. 293):

> Altaria nullo modo diruantur, sed, sicubi in nostris ecclesiis per homines turbulentos dirruta sunt, dent operam pii pastores, ut sine tumultibus restituantur. Et testimonia extant primitivae ecclesiae non in mensis ligneis, sed in altaribus administratam esse coenam Domini.

Let the altars in no wise be pulled down; but if anywhere in our churches they have been pulled down by turbulent men, let godly pastors take pains that they be restored without tumults. And testimonies of the primitive church are extant that the Lord's Supper was administered not on wooden tables but on altars.

#### 14.5.2 Where the minister stands

**Facing the people.** Several Saxon visitations order the altars arranged so that the minister faces the people. **Colditz, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 545):

> Zum zehenden das die altaria dermassen zugericht werden, domit der kirchendiner al sein kirchenampt gegen dem volk vorrichte

Tenthly, that the altars be so arranged, that the minister may perform all his church office toward the people.

**Gotha, *Artikel der Visitatoren*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 569):

> Zum andern das die abgöttische papistische bilder, so biblischer historien nicht gemess, in der kirchen nicht geduldet, auch die altaria dermassen zugericht werden sollen, das die priester mit den angesichte kegen dem volk gekart ihr ampt vorrichten mogen

Secondly, that the idolatrous popish images which are not agreeable to biblical histories be not suffered in the church; also that the altars shall be so arranged, that the priests may perform their office with the face turned toward the people.

**Not behind the table.** "Facing the people" did not yet mean standing behind a freestanding table. That posture was associated with Karlstadt and Müntzer (Radical Reformation), and the Wittenberg theologians condemned it. The *Wittenbergische Reformation* of 1545 hopes for a uniform Mass "with standing before the altar, that there be not such disorder as in some places, that the priests stand behind the table" (Sehling 1, p. 214). The Allstedt visitation of 1533, in Müntzer's former parish, orders every pastor to celebrate "not behind the altar, as some have done from the time of Thomas Müntzer until now, but to stand before the altar", and not to turn to the people at the elevation (Sehling 1, p. 510).

**Behind the table.** At the end of the century the Reformed princes ordered exactly that. In Anhalt in 1596 Johann Georg ordered the ministers to lay aside lights, Mass vestments and chasubles, to step behind the table "be it of stone or of wood", face the people and break the bread; the village officers were to remove the panels from the altars and the carved crucifixes from the churches, and set up a table in place of the altar. **Anhalt, *Verordnung Johann Georgs*, 3 November 1596** (Reformed; Sehling 2, p. 580):

> die lichter uf den altaren, mesgewant und caseln ablegen, bei administrirung und auspendunge des heiligen nachtmals des herren hinter dem dische (er sei steinern oder holzern) treten, das angesichte zu den volke kehren und geheiligete brot bei der austheilunge brechen und dem volke nach Christi wort und einsetzunge dasselbe geben solle, und das die schulzen und vorsteher die tafeln von dem altarn und die geschnitzte holzerne crucifix aus der kirchen hinweg thun, und anstatt des altars einen steinern oder holzern tisch

[that he] shall lay aside the lights upon the altars, Mass vestment and chasubles; at the administering and dealing out of the holy Supper of the Lord step behind the table (be it of stone or of wood), turn the face to the people, and break the hallowed

bread at the distribution, and give the same to the people according to Christ's word and institution; and that the village headmen and wardens put away the panels from the altars and the carved wooden crucifixes out of the church, and in place of the altar a table of stone or of wood [set up].

**Strasbourg 1537** (Moderate Reformed) had already set up an "altar-table" facing the people so that everyone might hear every word. **Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 270):

> komet der pfarrer und gehet für den altartisch, so sie gegen dem volck, damit jederman alle wort vernemmen mög, haben lassen auffrichten, und fahet an das gemein ampt mit nachgenden worten

the pastor cometh and goeth before the altar-table, which they have caused to be set up toward the people, that every man may perceive all the words, and beginneth the common office with the following words.

### 14.5.3 Tables in place of altars

The Reformed princes replaced altars with tables outright. **Simmern, *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre*, 2 October 1598** (Reformed, issued from Heidelberg after Simmern fell to the Electoral Palatinate; Sehling 19/2, p. 661):

> das in diesem gantzen ambt Simern allenthalben in den kirchen das gotzenwerck, altaria, tauffstein und dergleichen gentzlich abgeschafft unnd an der altarien statt gewonliche disch geordent werden sollen

that in this whole district of Simmern, everywhere in the churches, the idol-work, altars, fonts and the like shall be wholly abolished, and in the altars' stead ordinary tables be ordained.

The Casimirian mandate for the Palatinate in 1587 (Reformed) is a list of such measures. **Kurpfalz, *Casimirianische Kirchenordnung*, mandate, 1587** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 757):

> 13. An stat altarien soll man hultzern tisch in der kirchen machen und setzen lassen. 14. Kein tauffstein soll in der kirchen geduldet werden. 15. An stat der kleinen runden hostien soll man breite kuchen oder weck in einer schußeln uff den tisch in der kirchen stellen

13. In place of altars one shall cause wooden tables to be made and set in the church. 14. No font shall be suffered in the church. 15. In place of the little round hosts one shall set broad cakes or loaves in a dish upon the table in the church.

The Siegen mandate of 1581 (Reformed) likewise orders "the actual abolition of the idols, panels, organs, altars, chalices, and the ordering in their stead in each place of a table and a beaker" (Sehling 10, p. 158).

**Altar or table.** The Lutheran order of Marienhafe in East Frisia (1593), surrounded by Reformed churches, uses both words: each church is to have its own table-cloth, chalice, dish and can, "to use cleanly upon the altar or table of the Lord". **Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 710):

> Zum h. abentmall des Hern soll jede kirch eigen tischtug, kelch, schussel und kandel haben, aufen altar oder tisch des Hern fein sauber zu gebrauchen. Und sollens die communicanten kniend empfangen ahn einen ende des altars oder tisches das gesegentes [!] brot, ahm andren den kelch mit geburlicher reverenz und andacht.

For the holy Supper of the Lord each church shall have its own table-cloth, chalice, dish and can, to use finely and cleanly upon the altar or table of the Lord. And the communicants shall receive it kneeling: at one end of the altar or table the blessed bread, at the other the cup, with due reverence and devotion.

### 14.5.4 Lights

**Two candles.** The commonest Lutheran arrangement was two candles on the altar during the Supper. Allstedt 1533 orders "two burning lights during Mass" with alb and chasuble (§14.7.1), and the Calenberg synods of 1544/45 "two lights set upon the altar" (§14.7.1). Kurland 1570 has the sexton light both wax candles on the altar and a third on the pulpit, and forbids other lights by day. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 87):

> alsdenn bereitet der custos das altar, welchs allein zum gottesdienst und dem hochwirdigen sacrament verordnet, weil sonst keine andere oder mehr altare zugebrauchen, viel weniger nach papistischer gewonheit zuvergönnen, zündet auch an auf dem altar die beiden wachskerzen, wie in diesen landen allzeit gebreuchlich, desgleichen auf der canzel zündet er

> an das dritte licht, sonst sollen keine andere lichte bei hellem tage von deutschen oder undeutschen ihrer abgöttischen gewonheit nach gebraucht oder gestattet

then the sexton prepareth the altar, which is ordained only for the service of God and the most worthy sacrament, since no other or more altars are to be used, much less to be permitted after popish custom; he lighteth also upon the altar the two wax candles, as hath always been the use in these lands; likewise upon the pulpit he lighteth the third light; else shall no other lights in broad day be used or permitted, by Germans or non-Germans, after their idolatrous custom.

**Lights at the Supper.** The Hildesheim order of 1544 tells how an evangelical preacher, mocked for lighting candles on the altar in broad day, answered that Christ held his last supper at night in a hall full of lights. **Hildesheim, *Christlike kerckenordeninge*, 1544** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 852):

> Ein evangelisch prediger wert spottisch gefraget: Worumme stecke gy lichte an up dem altare ym lichten dage, dar gy wol können ane lichte seen? De prediger vant balde ein gudt antwort unde sprack: Wy holden dar des Heren aventmal. Christus helt syn leste aventmal unde gaff dat sacramente yn der nacht, do he vorraden wart, dar weren vele lichte yn dem groten sale umme der düster nacht willen. So steke wy nu ock lichte an, nicht umme der nodt willen ym klaren dage, sunder to bedüdende unde to betekende, dat wy dar holden nicht eine middagesmaltidt edder etent, sunder datsülve aventetent

An evangelical preacher was asked in mockery: Wherefore light ye lights upon the altar in the light of day, when ye can well see without lights? The preacher found a good answer straightway and spake: We hold there the Lord's Supper. Christ held his last supper and gave the sacrament in the night in which he was betrayed; there were many lights in the great hall because of the dark night. So we also now light lights, not for need's sake in clear day, but to signify and betoken that we hold there not a midday meal or eating, but that same evening meal.

**Wolfenbüttel 1569.** The Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel order wants the altar adorned with clean cloths and lights burning "because this is also kept in the neighbouring reformed churches", the people being taught that it is a free thing without superstition. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

> Es soll auch der altar mit reinen tüchern und andern ornatu gezieret und bekleidet sein, item liechte auf dem altar brennen, weil solches auch in den genachbarten reformierten kirchen gehalten, und kan gleichwoll das gemeine volk berichtet werden, das solchs nicht nothwendig, als das darin sonderlicher gottesdienst stünde oder die heiligung dieses sacraments daran gelegen, sonder wie ein frey mittelding ohne allen aberglauben gehalten werde.

The altar also shall be adorned and clothed with clean cloths and other ornaments; item, lights shall burn upon the altar, because the same is kept also in the neighbouring reformed churches; and yet the common people may be informed that such is not necessary, as though any special service of God stood therein or the hallowing of this sacrament lay thereon, but that it is kept as a free indifferent thing without all superstition.

Here "reformed" means the neighbouring evangelical churches, not the Calvinists. **Ansbach 1548**, an Interim order, wants the altar candles lit at the beginning of Mass and Vespers and not put out until the very end (Sehling 11, p. 327). Thüngen 1564 keeps them for peace (§14.3.3).

**One lamp.** The Palatine provisional order of 1546 (Lutheran; not an Interim order) reduces the lights to a single lamp and turns the cost of oil and wax to other uses. **Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 94):

> 7. Man soll nur ein ampel in der kirchen lassen, den uberigen kosten des oles und wachs abstellen, zu andern nötigen diensten der kirchen gebrauchen

7. One shall leave only one lamp in the church, [and] put down the remaining cost of oil and wax [and] use [it] for other needful services of the church.

**Abolished.** Regensburg dropped the lights with the Mass vestment (§14.7.3), and Anhalt in 1596 (Reformed) ordered them laid aside (§14.5.2).

**Lights for the Supper, not for the feast.** No order found varies the number of altar lights by the rank of a feast or by the season. Where the orders vary the lights, they vary them by whether the Supper is held. In the Prussian towns the lights are lit

with the Mass vestment when there are communicants, and on other Sundays the minister wears only the surplice. **Marggrabowa, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 4, p. 149):

> In ceremonien soll er nichts neues anfangen und alle zeit, wenn communikanten vorhanden, das messgewand gebrauchen, die lichte aufm altar lassen anzünden und da keine communikanten vorhanden, den chorrock alle zeit auf die sontage gebrauchen.

In ceremonies he shall begin nothing new, and at all times, when communicants are present, use the Mass vestment [and] cause the lights upon the altar to be lit; and when no communicants are present, use the surplice at all times on the Sundays.

The Sensburg order of the same year has the same words (Sehling 4, p. 151). At Suhl in Henneberg, by contrast, the whole Sunday service with communion, two and a half hours of ringing, singing, reading, preaching and communion, was held without any lights. **Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen*, 1562** (Sehling 2, p. 351):

> Dis alles geschicht ohn liechter, und wehret mit leuten, singen, lesen, predigt und communion bei dritthalber stund.

All this is done without lights, and lasteth, with ringing, singing, reading, sermon and communion, about two hours and a half.

The Gottorf visitors of 1587 still had to ask, parish by parish, whether the candles were lit or removed. **Gottorf, *Visitationsartikel*, 1587** (Sehling 23, p. 371):

> 11. An Vestitus Ecclesiasticus tam lineus quam sericus in administratione Coenae sit usitatus an abolitus, cerei accensi an remoti.

11. Whether the church vesture, linen as well as silk, be in use at the administration of the Supper or abolished; [whether] the candles be lighted or removed.

**Lights for the dark.** Other lights were plainly practical. In the Neumark the guilds, which had burned candles every Sunday and feast day, were to give wax yearly instead, so that the church might have light "in the winter when the day is short". **Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1 March 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 32):

> Nachdem auch gross und klein gewercke zuvoren alle sontage und feiertage auf den kerzen lichte gebrandt, sollen die rähte gleichfalls mit den gewerken auf einige anzahl wachses jehrlich zu geben, handelen, damit des winters wenn der tag kurz ist, lichte zur notturft der kirchen möchte gehabt und gebraucht werden.

Whereas also the great and small crafts formerly burned lights on the candles every Sunday and feast day, the councils shall likewise treat with the crafts to give a certain quantity of wax yearly, that in winter, when the day is short, lights may be had and used for the need of the church.

**The eternal light.** The endowments for the perpetual lamp went into the common chest with the endowments for Masses and vigils. **Württemberg, *Kastenordnung*, 1536** (Sehling 16, p. 96):

> Erstlich, von bestendigem und gewissem einkommen soll zusamen geschlagen unnd in ein Kasten eingezogen werden alles, was bißanher auff messen, vigilien, ewigen liecht, wachs und öl gewendt ist worden.

First, of steady and certain income there shall be put together and drawn into one chest all that hath hitherto been spent on Masses, vigils, the eternal light, wax and oil.

The Württemberg order of 1552 repeats the clause (Sehling 16, p. 202). The single lamp of Kurpfalz 1546, which the editor takes for the eternal light, is the only one found kept.

**Blessed candles.** The blessing of candles at Candlemas was abolished. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 49):

> Interdicimus autem in virtute omnipotentis Dei, ne quis in ipsis festis quicquam agat eorum, quae hactenus contra puritatem sermonum Dei introducta fuerunt, ut sunt benedictio candelarum in die praesentationis, et superstitiones, quae in diebus aliis praescriptis servabantur.

But we forbid in the power of almighty God that anyone do on these feasts any of those things which have hitherto been brought in against the purity of the words of God, as are the blessing of candles on the day of the Presentation, and the

superstitions which were observed on the other days prescribed.

Brandenburg 1540 drops the blessing of "herbs, lights and other things" (Sehling 3, p. 88). Schweinfurt 1543 has the Candlemas preacher lead the people "from the folly and idolatry which they formerly had with the lights" to Christ, "the true, eternal light" (Sehling 11, p. 635). Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 forbids blessing the paschal candle (*osterstock*) with the Easter fire (§14.6.6), and the Lüneburg convent reform of 1555 stops the prioress's blessing of palms, Easter candles, water and fire. **Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555** (Sehling 6/1, p. 615):

> Weil dann die domina ein zeitlang die palm, osterkerzen, wasser und feuer geweihet hat und aber solchs ihr nicht geburet, dann es ohne das Gottes guthe creaturen sein und kein befelich in heiliger schrift darvon ist, sonder derselbigen mehr zuwider, so sol solchs furder underlassen werden.

Since then the prioress for a time hath hallowed the palms, Easter candles, water and fire, and yet such belongeth not to her, for they are without that God's good creatures, and there is no command thereof in holy Scripture, but rather it is contrary thereto, so shall the same henceforth be left off.

**Tenebrae.** The Holy Week *Tenebrae* survived in the Lutheran orders only as the responsory *Tenebrae factae sunt*, sung on Fridays or Good Friday, and in places as a Friday bell. No order keeps the hearse of candles put out one by one. Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 keeps the three Holy Week Matins "but without any knocking, rumbling and din" (Sehling 13, p. 95), the noise that ended the office in the dark.

#### 14.5.5 The sacrament house

The evangelical orders gave communion at once and did not reserve the Sacrament, so the sacrament house lost its purpose. Hohenlohe 1553 forbids the Sacrament to be "kept, locked up or carried about" (Sehling 15, p. 77). **Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 18 October 1542** (Sehling 2, p. 175):

> 9. Sie sollen kein sacrament noch crysma oder dergl. in dem sacrament häuslein halten, noch brennende lampen dafür leiden.

9. They shall keep no sacrament nor chrism or the like in the sacrament house, nor suffer burning lamps before it.

**Ambries.** The Homberg synod (Moderate Reformed) forbids reservation in any form, "in ambries or little boxes". **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

> [27] Quia usus sanctae eucharistiae est perceptio eius, et communio fidelium in Christi commemorationem, nullibi a modo in armariis seu arcellis reservetur, nullaque ratione circumferatur. Haec namque figmenta hominum sunt, ideoque vitanda.

[27] Because the use of the holy eucharist is the receiving of it, and the communion of the faithful in remembrance of Christ, let it henceforth nowhere be reserved in ambries or little boxes, and by no means be carried about. For these are figments of men, and therefore to be shunned.

No order uses "tabernacle" (*Tabernakel*) for a furnishing. The word occurs only for the tabernacle of Israel and in the psalms.

**Removal.** The Pfalz-Neuburg visitation of 1560 counts sacrament houses and altars not used for communion among "idolatrous images", to be removed "with Christian discretion", as in the Upper Palatinate. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1560** (Sehling 13, p. 135):

> So werden wir bericht, das noch abgöttische bilder als sacramentheuslein und altaria, so man nit zur communion gebraucht, in etlichen kirchen sein. Da sollen unsere visitatores uf mitl und weg denken, ob und wie solche bilder und anders, so zur abgötterei ursach geben kan, mit christlicher beschaidenhait abzuschaffen

So are we informed that idolatrous images, as sacrament houses and altars which are not used for the communion, are still in some churches. There shall our visitors think upon means and ways, whether and how such images and other things which can give cause for idolatry may be abolished with Christian discretion.

**Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576** (Sehling 10, p. 310), joins them with the ossuary:

> 27. Hieher gehören auch die ubergebliebene Todtenbein [=Ossuarium] und genannte Heyligen- wie auch Sacramenthäußlin, die man gäntzlich soll abschaffen unnd die Todtenbeyn auff den Gottsacker in die Erde verscharren und begraben.

27. Hither belong also the remaining dead men's bones [= ossuary] and the so-called saints' and also sacrament houses, which one shall wholly abolish, and bury and inter the dead men's bones in the earth in the churchyard.

Magdeburg 1583 (§14.3.2) and Kurpfalz 1565 (Reformed; §14.4.4) name the sacrament house too.

#### 14.5.6 The font

**Kept.** The Prussian order of 1525 baptizes in plain water "in the customary font, which may be renewed as often as is needful". **Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung*, 10 December 1525** (Sehling 4, p. 33):

> Die tauf sol gescheen in der kirchen wie vor, alleine in lauterem wasser, darzu im gewonlichen taufstein erhalten, welchs mag verneuet werden, so oft es von nöten ist, und bedarf nicht der osterlichen alten ceremonien, auch keines öls oder cresems

Baptism shall be done in the church as before, only in pure water, kept therefor in the customary font, which may be renewed as oft as it is needful; and it needeth not the old Easter ceremonies, nor any oil or chrism.

**Moved to sight.** Baptism was to be public, and the font was moved accordingly. Lüneburg 1564 sets the fonts "up before the choir and a step or two high". **Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 554):

> Derwegen ordenen und setzen wir, das in allen pfarren unsers fürstenthumbs die taufsteine, wo es nicht allbereit geschehen, oben vor dem chor und ein trit oder zween in die höhe gesetzet werden sollen

Therefore we ordain and appoint that in all parishes of our principality the fonts, where it hath not already been done, shall be set up before the choir, and a step or two on high.

Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588 (Reformed) moves the fonts "out of the corners before the face of the church, as hath been done also in many reformed churches of the German nation". **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 268):

> Es sollen auch die Baptisteria oder Tauffsteine auß den Winckelen für das Angesicht der Kirchen geruckt werden, Wie dann auch in vielen reformirten Kirchen teutscher Nation beschehen

The baptisteries or fonts also shall be moved out of the corners before the face of the church, as hath been done also in many reformed churches of the German nation.

**Adorned.** Kaspar Löner at Nördlingen asks the council to rail the font about and adorn it. **Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544** (Sehling 12, p. 314):

> Dazu ist auch mein bit, euere erbare weisheit wöllen den taufstein umbgittern und ziern lassen.

Thereto is also my request, that your honourable wisdom will cause the font to be railed about and adorned.

Kurland 1570 wants "a special, glorious font or font-vessel, with the needful two towels and cloths" (Sehling 5, p. 99).

**Warm water.** Bremen 1534 tells the sexton to provide warm water in a basin in frosty weather, so that baptism, given for salvation, does the child's body no harm. **Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 439):

> Im Wynter, wenn ydt gefraren ys, schal men dem köster anseggen, dat he warm water vorschaffe (nicht mit synem schaden unde nadeel) yn ein becken, dat de döpe, tho der salicheit gegeven, nicht dem kindeken am live schade

In winter, when it is frozen, one shall tell the sexton that he provide warm water (not to his own harm and hurt) in a basin, that the baptism, given for salvation, harm not the little child in its body.

**Abolished.** The Reformed orders removed the font altogether: Kurpfalz 1565 (§14.4.4), the Casimirian mandate of 1587 and Simmern 1598 (§14.5.3), all Reformed. The Lutheran Sponheim in 1607 complains that the "old, abolished fonts and corner-Mass

altars" ordered removed still lie broken in some churches, "a great unseemliness" (Sehling 18, p. 669).

#### 14.5.7 Pulpit, screens, pews, galleries and windows

**The pulpit.** The orders say little of the pulpit's form. It appears with altar and font as a thing to be covered (§14.6.1) and kept, and in Kurland it bears the third light (§14.5.4).

**The choir screen.** The Zweibrücken visitation of 1558 orders the screen in the nuns' choir "torn away", so that the preacher can see that they hear the sermon. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Visitationsordnung*, 1558** (Sehling 18, p. 270):

> Mittler zeit aber, biß solche verenderung vorgenomen, sollen sy mit ernst angehallten werden, die predig Gottes worts zehörn, und darmit mann ihrer gewiß, das dieselbig von ihnen allen besuecht, soll ihnen das gitter uff dem Chor hinweg gerissen werden, das sy von einem prediger gesehen und sich nicht abziehen köndten.

But in the meantime, until such change be undertaken, they shall be earnestly held to hear the preaching of God's word; and that one may be sure of them, that the same be attended by all of them, the grating in the choir shall be torn away from them, that they may be seen by a preacher and could not withdraw themselves.

Saalfeld 1533 removes "all screens" (*gitter*) with the side altars, and Grubenhagen 1544 lists *schranken* among the things to be cleared (§14.4.2).

**Pews.** By the later sixteenth century the nave was filling with pews, and the orders regulate them. Electoral Saxony in 1580 complains that pews built "here and there" block the view of the pulpit and of the altar at communion. **Saxony, *Ordnung Herzog Augusts*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 451):

> XXXVI. Von den stülen in der kirchen. Nach dem auch eine gemeine klage einkommen, das hin und wider in die kirchen stüle gebauet, dardurch die leute verhindert, das sie weder den prediger auf der canzel, noch zu dem altar, wenn das hochwirdige sacrament ausgeteilet wird, sehen können, desgleichen auch oftmals solche stüle in den gemeinen gengen aufgerichtet, das die leute für denselben nicht wol hin und wieder gehen können. Derwegen sol in den kirchen auf den dörfern und stedten hinfüro kein stuel ohne sonderlich vorwissen und erlaubnis des pfarrers und der kirchveter gebauet werden.

XXXVI. Of the pews in the church. Whereas also a common complaint hath come in, that here and there pews are built into the churches, whereby the people are hindered, that they can see neither the preacher in the pulpit nor [toward] the altar when the most worthy sacrament is dealt out; likewise also oftentimes such pews are set up in the common gangways, so that the people cannot well go to and fro before them: therefore in the churches in the villages and towns henceforth no pew shall be built without the special knowledge and leave of the pastor and the churchwardens.

No pew is to be hereditary; it is granted only for the holder's lifetime. At Hadersleben in 1571 Duke Johann ordered the old pews in the church torn out and new ones built, because a corpse could not be carried up the middle of the church and men and women stood mixed on both sides. **Hadersleben, *Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen*, 31 May 1571** (Sehling 23, p. 242):

> Nachdem unser thumbkirch zu Haderschleben mit stulen dermasen bebawet, das man mit keinem leich mitten in der kirchen khommen, sunder mit grosem beschwer dasselbe ander wegen umbher zu seiner legerstedte bringen mus, auch sunst diese unordenunge zubefinden, das mans und frawen personen uff beiden seiten durcheinander stehen

Whereas our cathedral church at Hadersleben is so built up with pews that one cannot come with any corpse up the middle of the church, but must bring the same with great trouble by other ways round about to its resting-place; also this disorder is found besides, that men and women persons stand one among another on both sides.

Thorn (1599) and Stargard (1596) have whole pew orders (Sehling 4, pp. 244, 520–521).

**Galleries.** The Wittenberg order of 1533 sends the schoolboys who cannot fit into the stall in the middle of the church up the tower stair to "the north gallery", to sing with those below and keep quiet. **Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 704):

> mit den andern aber, die in den stuel nicht kommen mogen, soll ein schuldiener ordenlich in die thurmthur gehen und in aller stille auf die borkirchen gegen mitternacht steigen, aldo mit singen, was man darunten singt, auch vleissig aufsehen,

> das die kinder stil sein, predig horen und nicht büberei treiben.

but with the others, which cannot come into the stall, a school servant shall go in order into the tower door and climb in all quietness up to the gallery toward midnight, there to sing with what is sung beneath, [and] also look diligently that the children be still, hear the sermon, and do no knavery.

Saxony 1580 forbids "levity and mischief with laughing, chattering or the like" on the galleries (Sehling 1, p. 440).

**Windows.** In the Neumark the craft guilds, which had once kept altars with their panels and candlesticks, were each to keep up one window in the parish church instead. **Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1 March 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 32):

> Die fenster. So dan von alters die werke in städten gemeiniglich sonderlich stiefft vorleichen gehabt dorzu sie einen altar mit tafeln leuchtern und andern altar geräthe haben erhalten müssen, sehen wir vor gut an, dos ein raht einer jeden stadt mit ihren werken handele, das sie dagegen ein jedes werk ein sonderliches fenster in der pfarrkirchen für und für erhalten

The windows. Whereas of old the crafts in towns commonly had special foundations granted to them, whereto they had to maintain an altar with panels, candlesticks and other altar-gear, we think it good that the council of each town treat with its crafts, that in return each craft maintain a particular window in the parish church for ever.

Salzwedel 1579 and other Brandenburg visitations order the council to make the guilds repair the windows they were wont to keep (Sehling 3, p. 285). Nothing is said of what the glass showed.

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## 14.6 Paraments, linens and vessels

### 14.6.1 Covers for altar, pulpit and font

**White linen.** The orders seldom name individual paraments. What they ask for is that altar, pulpit and font be decently covered and clean. Anhalt 1562 wants altar and font "adorned with white linen cloths or tapestries" (§14.4.5), and Wolfenbüttel 1569 the altar "adorned and clothed with clean cloths and other ornaments" (§14.5.4).

**Henneberg 1556.** The Henneberg visitors at Römhild ordered fine covers made "from the ornaments", that is, from the old vestments, for altar, pulpit and font, with a funeral pall and a fine little cloth for the communicants. **Henneberg, *Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild*, 20 December 1556** (Sehling 2, p. 328):

> Zum eilften in allen kirchen von ornat lassen schone deck machen umb den altar, predigstul, taufstein, leichtuch, ein schön tauftuchlin fur die communicantes

Eleventhly, in all churches to cause fine covers to be made from the ornaments, about the altar, pulpit, font; a pall; a fine little cloth for the communicants.

The Leiningen-Hardenburg visitation articles of 1609 ask the visitors to inquire whether "their altar, font, pulpit, desk, etc., are covered as is due". **Leiningen-Hardenburg, *Visitations- und Täuferordnung*, 1609** (Sehling 19/1, p. 315):

> 42. Ob ihre altar, tauffstein, predigstul, pult etc. der gebühr bedeckt seyen?

42. Whether their altar, font, pulpit, desk, etc., be covered as is due?

The reading desk (*Pult*) appears here among the furnishings to be covered. No order names a lectern fall, superfrontal, dossal or runner.

**Old vestments made into altar cloths.** The Sponheim order of 1590/91, a Lutheran order, turns surplices and Mass vestments into altar cloths, and gives what is of little use to the poor. **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung*, 1590/91** (Sehling 18, p. 653):

> 15. Crucifix unnd anndere bilder, so noch vorhanndenn sein, soll mann hinweg thun unnd abschaffenn, Chorröck oder Chorhembder und Meßgewanndt sollenn zu altaar tucher zugericht werden, wo aber sie wenig nuz oder nicht zu gebrauchen, hatt mann es armen leuthen zu gebenn.

15. Crucifix and other images which are still present one shall put away and abolish; surplices or choir shirts and Mass vestments shall be made up into altar cloths; but where they are of little use or not to be used, one is to give it to poor folk.

### 14.6.2 Corporal and pall

**Brandenburg 1540.** The corporal and pall appear in the rite for the sick. The priest is to have a special chalice kept for the purpose, a corporal, the hosts in a case, a vessel for wine, "a special pall wherewith to cover the table further", a surplice and a light. **Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 80):

> Der priester aber sol ein sonderlichen kilch, darzu verordent, an eim bequemen ort haben, sampt einem corporal, und in einem futter die partes, darzu auch ein gefess zum wein, auch ein sonderlich palla, damit er den tisch ferner bedecken, item auch ein korrock und licht.

But the priest shall have a special chalice, ordained thereto, in a convenient place, together with a corporal, and in a case the particles, thereto also a vessel for the wine, also a special pall wherewith to cover the table further; item also a surplice and light.

No order in the corpus regulates the purificator, burse, chalice veil, lavabo or credence. The lavabo went with the offertory, which the evangelical orders dropped.

### 14.6.3 The communion cloth

**Held by boys or men.** Many Lutheran orders kept the cloth held under the communicants' chins, "to prevent mishap". At Hohenlohe two honest men go to the altar with a silk cloth and little kneeling benches. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 15, p. 71):

> Alsdann sollen zwen erbare menner mit einem seidenim duchlein und kleinen benklin, daruf die comunicanten niderknien, sich zum altar verfuegen

Then shall two honest men betake themselves to the altar with a silken little cloth and small benches, whereon the communicants kneel down.

At Regensburg under Justus Jonas the deacons hold it in surplices. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553** (Sehling 13, p. 421):

> Der diaconus aber, so tercius ist, helt das tuechlein auf des priesters seiten, der den leib raicht. Derjenig aber, so quartus ist, helt das tuechle bei dem diacono, der das bluet raicht, in einem chorrock.

But the deacon who is third holdeth the little cloth on the side of the priest who reacheth the body. But he that is fourth holdeth the little cloth by the deacon who reacheth the blood, in a surplice.

At Speyer two boys hold the cloths "for the more reverence's sake". **Speyer, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 19/1, p. 92):

> dartzu zwen jungen, so die tuchlein umb meher reverentz willen halten, geprauchт werden sollen.

whereto two boys, which hold the little cloths for more reverence's sake, shall be used.

At Thorn boys stand on both sides of the altar with silk cloths, while the priests minister in chasuble and surplice. **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 237):

> Unter diesem stehen wie im ganzen amte die priester mit gewohnlichen kirchenkleidern, kasel und chorrock angethan und reichen dem volke das sacrament des leibes und blutes Jesu Christi, da auch zu beiden seiten des altars knaben stehen, die seidene tüchlein halten, unrath zuverhüten

Under this the priests stand, as in the whole office, clad in the customary church clothes, chasuble and surplice, and reach to the people the sacrament of the body and blood of Jesus Christ; where also on both sides of the altar boys stand, which hold silken little cloths, to prevent mishap.

**Abolished.** The Palatine Calvinists (Reformed) abolished the cloth with the surplice. **Kurpfalz, *Amberger Mandat*, 20 January 1567** (Reformed; Sehling 13, p. 303):

> Zum andern, das das tuchlein, so man den comunicanten underhelt, abgeschafft werde.

Secondly, that the little cloth which is held under the communicants be abolished.

The Upper Palatinate visitation of 1579, a Lutheran order of Elector Ludwig VI, orders both things dropped; *verbleiben* here means "be left off", as the editor notes. **Upper Palatinate, *Visitationsordnung*, 1579** (Sehling 13, p. 315):

> 3. Das der chorrock und die duchlein hinfort allerding verbleiben sollen, wie sich denn churf[ürstliche] pfalz uf etlicher entschuldigung des chorrocks halben expresse dahin erclert.

3. That the surplice and the little cloths shall henceforth be left off altogether, as the Electoral Palatinate hath expressly declared itself thereto upon the excuse of some touching the surplice.

When the parish of Sallern resisted, the elector ordered the abolition carried through, but only after the superintendent or pastor had preached to the people "de adiaphoris" (Sehling 13, p. 315). Nassau-Weilburg in 1617 abolishes the cloth "still held before the communicants in a few places". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1617** (Sehling 10, p. 351):

> 4. Wir seindt berichtet, das noch an etlichen wenig orten den communicanten ein tüchlein vorgehalten werde indem sie zue des herren disch gehen, daßelbige soll hiermit abgeschafft sein

4. We are informed that still in some few places a little cloth is held before the communicants as they go to the Lord's table; the same shall herewith be abolished.

#### 14.6.4 The stock of vestments

**Inventories.** The first Saxon visitations dealt with paraments as property. At Schmiedeberg in 1528 two chalices and the three best Mass vestments are kept for the Mass; the albs are cut up for bed sheets in the hospital, and the rest sold for the common chest. **Schmiedeberg, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1528** (Sehling 1, p. 664):

> Zwen kelch und drei messgewant die besten sollen zum gebrauch der messen behalten, was von alben ist zurschneiden in das hospital zur notturft der armen zu bettüchern gegeben, und die übrigen alben und kasslen verkauft, und das kaufgelt in den gemeinen kasten

Two chalices and three Mass vestments, the best, shall be kept for the use of the Mass; what there is of albs, cut up [and] given into the hospital for bed sheets for the need of the poor; and the remaining albs and chasubles sold, and the purchase money [put] into the common chest.

Zahna 1528 has the same provision (Sehling 1, p. 713).

**No new purchases.** The Homberg synod (Moderate Reformed) forbids any further outlay on altar paraments, chasubles, copes or mantles; what was spent on them is to go to the poor. A minister who has a chasuble may use it at the Supper or not. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 45):

> [22] Amodo nullae fiant impensae pro altariorum paramentis, casulis, cappis seu chlamidibus et similibus, sed magis dispensentur egenis, quae in his frustra consumi consueverunt. Nimirum qui se putat in his colere Deum, sine causa id facit, quod sint purae et vanae hominum traditiones. Liberum autem sit habenti casulam eadem in coenae dominicae ministerio uti vel non, tamen de caetero haud quaquam emantur

[22] From henceforth let no outlays be made for the paraments of altars, chasubles, copes or mantles and the like; but let that which was wont to be spent in vain on these be dispensed rather to the needy. Truly, he that thinketh to worship God in these doeth it without cause, for they are pure and vain traditions of men. But let it be free to him that hath a chasuble to use the same in the ministry of the Lord's Supper or not; yet for the rest let them by no means be bought.

#### 14.6.5 Chalices and beakers

**Two chalices.** Kurland 1570 wants two chalices in every parish, "one for the healthy, the other for the sick" (Sehling 5, p. 99), and Brandenburg 1540 a separate chalice for the sick (§14.6.2).

**Beakers.** The Reformed replaced chalices with beakers. The Casimirian mandate of 1587 (Reformed) orders all but one of the chalices sent to the treasury and silver beakers used instead (Sehling 19/2, p. 757), and Siegen 1581 (Reformed) orders "a table and a beaker" (§14.5.3). At Zweibrücken in 1595, now Reformed, all chalices and patens were to be collected after Easter and handed to the goldsmiths to make beakers "for the more conformity with other reformed evangelical churches". **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra*, 7 April 1595** (Reformed; Sehling 18, p. 410):

> Nachdem auch ann statt der kelch, so mann bishero in administrirung des heilgen abentmals gebraucht, hinfüro umb mehrer gleichförmigkeit willen mit andern reformirten evangelischen Kirchen laut hiemit kommender ordnung silberne Becher gebraucht werden sollen, so ist hiemitt unser gnediger befelch, das ir den kirchenscheffner euers ahnbevolhenen ambts ufferleget, alle Kelch sambt den Patenen, sie seien waß materi, sie wöllen, zusammen zu bringen

Whereas also in stead of the chalices, which hitherto have been used in administering the holy Supper, henceforth, for the sake of more conformity with other reformed evangelical churches, according to the order herewith coming, silver beakers shall be used: so is herewith our gracious command, that ye lay upon the church steward of your committed district to bring together all chalices together with the patens, be they of what material they will.

#### 14.6.6 Colours and the seasons

**No sequence of colours.** No order in the corpus prescribes liturgical colours, or a change of vestments or paraments by season or feast. The only accounts of the seasonal colour sequence are the editor's notes on the chasuble (for example Sehling 6/1, p. 424). Riga 1530 allows a cope or chasuble on the high feasts over the plain surplice, and Kurland 1570 "other silken vestments, chasubles, Mass vestment" on the high feasts "for a change" (§14.7.1). Neither says anything of colour.

**Coloured vestments in use.** Inventories show that coloured vestments remained in use and were even given new. The Mecklenburg visitors of 1578 found at Fürstenberg a red-and-green velvet chasuble that Duke Johann Albrecht had given that very summer, a red velvet chasuble, two red damask deacon's coats and two brass candlesticks on the altar. **Mecklenburg, *Ordnung der Visitatoren für Fürstenberg*, 1578** (Sehling 5, p. 265):

> Inventarium. Drei silberne verguldete kilch. Zwei silberne verguldete patenen. Eine rote und grüne verteilte sampte kasell mit kleinen vergülten spengelin, das kreutz auf dem rugge mit der andern zugehorunge. Die hat M. G. F. und herr herr Johans Albrecht etc. diesen itzigen sommer zu Fürstenburgk in die kirche gegeben. Eine rote sammet kasell samt der zugehörunge. Noch zwei andere alte kaseln, die werden nicht gebraucht. Zwei rote dammaschen diakon röcke mit vergülten borten vorsetzet, und sunst das leinen wandt, das man notturftiglich zum altar gebraucht. Zwei misinsche leuchter auf dem altar.

Inventory. Three silver gilt chalices. Two silver gilt patens. A red and green parted velvet chasuble with small gilt clasps, the cross on the back, with the other appurtenances; the same hath my gracious prince and lord, lord Johann Albrecht, etc., given into the church at Fürstenberg this present summer. A red velvet chasuble together with its appurtenances. Two other old chasubles besides, which are not used. Two red damask deacon's coats set with gilt borders; and otherwise the linen cloth which is needfully used for the altar. Two brass candlesticks on the altar.

At Sorau in Lower Lusatia, the boys who held the communion cloths wore red choir smocks and green wreaths on their heads. The extract of the Sorau order of 1595 is known only from a chronicle of 1710, which lists it among customs "named therein and since fallen out of use". **Sorau, *Kirchenordnung*, extract after J. S. Magnus, 1595** (Sehling 3, p. 372):

> 1. An hohen festtagen giengen alle personen, die in der kirche waren, männer und weiber, jung und alt zum opfer. 2. Nach geschehener consecration des brods und weins beim heil, abendmahl war die elevatio gebräuchlich. 3. Die knaben, so auf seiten des altars die tüchlein hielten, hatten rote chorkittel und grüne kränzlein auf ihren häuptern.

1. On high feast days all persons who were in the church, men and women, young and old, went to the offering. 2. After the consecration of the bread and wine was done at the holy Supper, the elevation was in use. 3. The boys who held the little cloths at the sides of the altar had red choir smocks and green garlands upon their heads.

The only other colours prescribed are those of mourning and penance: the black velvet pall with a white cross on the Mansfeld oath table (§14.4.5), and the black cloths hired out for funerals at Breslau in 1528 (Sehling 3, p. 399).

**Veiling in Lent and Holy Week.** The Lenten veiling of images is mentioned in only a handful of places in the corpus, and always in order to end it. Luther's *Deutsche Messe* rejects the Lenten veil ("hunger cloth") and the covering of images (§14.4.1). No order keeps either, and none prescribes veiling crosses or images in Passiontide.

The Mülhausen preachers' opinion on Holy Week of 1528 (Reformed) shows the other end of the veiling: the crucifix unveiled and shown at the Good Friday office. They ask that this "may well be left off, with some chants", together with the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre and the wooden clappers. **Mülhausen, *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche*, [1528]** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 207):

> Des glichen die begrebniß des herrn yn das grab mitt andern brüchen abgestelt werde, ouch, das man nit mitt den hulzernen tafeln klöpfet, sunder wie andere mol mitt den gloggen zu den ämptern lüte. Man möcht auch wol das crucifix, so dann an dem selbigen tag in dem ampt zeigt wirdt, mitt etlichen gsangen underlassen.

Likewise that the burial of the Lord in the sepulchre, with other uses, be put down; also that one knock not with the wooden boards, but ring to the offices with the bells as at other times. One might also well leave off the crucifix which is shown on that same day in the office, with some chants.

The same opinion stops the washing of the altars in Holy Week, unless a man wishes to wash his own altar (Sehling 20/2, p. 206).

**Veiled, but removed all the same.** At Regensburg a carved Coronation of Mary on the high altar had been kept covered, apparently as a compromise. It was nonetheless taken away and replaced by a painted panel of the "sum of the evangelical preaching". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

> Hernach ist gleicherweis die coronatio Mariae zur himmelkönigin auf dem hohen altar, wiewol verdeckt, dennoch hinweggereumt, dargegen aber anstat aufgericht ein gemalte tafel auf demselben altar, darin die summa der evangelischen predigten altes und neues testaments zu sehen.

Afterward the Coronation of Mary as Queen of Heaven on the high altar was likewise, although covered, nevertheless cleared away, and in its stead a painted panel set up upon the same altar, wherein the sum of the evangelical preaching of the Old and New Testament is to be seen.

**Other Holy Week furnishings.** The image plays of the church year went with the veils, as did the Easter sepulchre, the paschal candle and the blessings of the seasons. For the sepulchre and the Good Friday rite, see Chapter 13, §13.20.4. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 96):

> Dargegen sollen unterwegen bleiben erstlich alle spectacula und schauspil, so man mit bildern getriben hat als am Palmtag mit dem esel, am Karfreitag mit dem crucifix und grab, am Ostertag mit umbtragen des bilds der urstend Christi, am Auffartstag mit aufziehung desselben, am Pfingstag mit herablassen der tauben, am Christag mit dem kindlein wiegen und alles, was dergleichen allenthalben oder an etlichen fordern orten im brauch gewest ist. […] Man sol auch nicht mer weihen oder segnen weihwasser und salz, wie alle sonntag beschehen, noch wachs zu Lichtmeß [2. Februar] noch aeschen am Aschermitwoch noch palmen am palmtag noch osterstock noch tauf noch feur am osterabent

On the other hand there shall be left off, first, all spectacles and plays which have been practised with images: as on Palm Sunday with the ass, on Good Friday with the crucifix and the sepulchre, on Easter Day with carrying about the image of the resurrection of Christ, on Ascension Day with drawing up the same, on Whitsunday with letting down the dove, on Christmas Day with rocking the little child, and all that hath been in use of the like kind everywhere or in some places heretofore. […] Neither shall one any more hallow or bless holy water and salt, as was done every Sunday, nor wax at Candlemas [2 February], nor ashes on Ash Wednesday, nor palms on Palm Sunday, nor the paschal candle, nor the font, nor the fire on Easter Eve.

Hohenlohe 1553 repeats the list of image plays almost word for word (Sehling 15, p. 77).

**Greenery and flowers.** The orders treat seasonal greenery as folk custom, not as church furnishing. The Leiningen-Westerburg discipline order of 1566 forbids, among the "heathen" customs of Shrovetide and the year, setting up May branches, carrying banners and decking the church with flowers. **Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566** (Sehling 19/1, p. 227):

> So dannoch der Haidnisch wandel getrieben und gehalten würt, nemlich mit pratten heischen, Butzen gehn, Lehen außruffen, Mayen stecken, Hagel baum brennen, Johans feuwer machen unnd drüber springen, auch andere Gottlose

> narrenwerck, Fahnen tragen, Kirchen blümen unnd gegen dem Wetter leutten ubet, So wöllen Wir, daß solch ergerlich unnd unGöttlich wesen unnd werck abgeschafft

Whereas nevertheless heathenish conduct is practised and kept, namely with begging for roasts, going about in masks, crying out the "fiefs", setting up May branches, burning the hail-tree, making St John's fires and leaping over them, and other godless fool's-work, carrying banners, decking the church with flowers, and ringing against the weather: so will we that such offensive and ungodly conduct and work be abolished.

The Palatine mandates of 1562 (Reformed) likewise forbid the young men and maids to set up May branches (Sehling 14, pp. 272–273). The one approving mention is at Hof. On the anniversary of the 1572 dedication of St Michael's, the neighbours strewed the lane with grass and set up "fine May branches" on both sides for the procession, "to the honour of God and his church" (Sehling 11, p. 467; see Chapter 13, §13.14.3).

**Not found.** No order mentions an Advent wreath, a Christmas tree, a crib set up in church (only the rocking of the Christ-child, abolished), or Easter flowers. The Advent wreath and the church Christmas tree belong to later centuries.

#### 14.6.7 The paten, the host box and the bread dish

**The searches.** The corpus was searched for the paten (*Patene*, *Paten*, *patena*, *patina*, *pateen*; 140 passages once the many godparents, also *Paten*, were set aside). It was also searched for the vessels beside it: the box for the hosts (*Büchse*, *Lade*, *Schachtel*, *Kapsel*, *pyxis*, *ciborium*) and the Reformed dish or plate (*Schüssel*, *Teller*, *Platte*).

**An ordinary vessel, kept.** The Lutheran orders kept the paten as they kept the chalice, as a plain instrument of the Supper. Hannover (1536): "We use the customary vessels for the administration of the holy sacraments: chalice, paten, etc. For what Scripture doth not forbid, that we will not let be forbidden us" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1005). The paten was set out on the altar with the other things:

- **Regensburg (1542):** the epistoler "setteth the chalice, book, particles and paten on the altar" (Sehling 13, p. 391).
- **Regensburg (1567):** the priest and the *secundus* carry chalice and paten out of the sacristy, and the *secundus* unwraps them and makes them ready on the altar (Sehling 13, p. 462).
- **Ritzebüttel (1556):** the priest stands at the altar in the customary Mass vestment, with "paten, chalice, bread and wine and burning wax lights" set on it (Sehling 5, p. 558).
- **Gottleuba (1567):** "in the office they use lighted candles on the altar, chalice, paten, Mass vestment and all other ornaments" (Sehling 1, p. 567).
- **Danzig (1557):** the sexton is to watch "so long as the book, the can, the chalice and the paten stand on the altar", that no harm or theft befall them (Sehling 4, p. 214).
- **Strasbourg (1598):** a box with the particles, a can of wine, the chalice and the paten are set on the altar at the beginning of the service (Sehling 20/1, p. 611).

**In the hand at the Words of Institution.** The commonest rubric puts the paten, with as many hosts as there are communicants, into the minister's hand while he says or sings the words over the bread. **Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546** (Sehling 14, p. 97):

> Und wann er uf diese wort khompt: name er das brot, so nymbt er die paten, daruf die hostia alle liegen, sovil der communicanten, die sich dann zuvor angezeigt, absolvirt und zugelassen sein, in die hende und, wann die verba consecrationis vollendet sein, legt ers wider von sich. Deßgleichen thut er auch nachvolgents mit dem kelch

And when he cometh to these words, "he took the bread", he taketh the paten, on which lie all the hosts, as many as there are communicants who have announced themselves beforehand, been absolved and admitted, into his hands; and when the words of consecration are finished, he layeth it away from him again. Likewise doth he afterwards also with the chalice.

The same rubric appears in many orders:

- **Livonia (1533):** the priest takes "the bread upon the paten into his hand", turns about over the altar toward the people, and speaks the words aloud (Sehling 5, p. 16).
- **Mecklenburg (1540/1545):** after the Lord's Prayer he "taketh the paten with the bread into his hand" and sings the Verba, turned toward the altar (Sehling 5, p. 154).

- **The *Cellische Ordnungen* (1545):** the priest lays "as many particles as belong to the communicants" in the paten, turns with it toward the people, and says the Verba in German (Sehling 1, p. 301).
- **Danzig (1557):** he takes "the paten with the appointed host into his hand without all papistical crossing and other gestures" (Sehling 4, p. 168).
- **Neuenrade (1564):** "he taketh the paten with the bread and turneth to the people" (Sehling 22, p. 519).
- **Schwarzburg (1574):** "he taketh the paten of the bread, wherein are as many particles as there are communicants" (Sehling 2, p. 133).
- **Henneberg (1582):** the minister shall "always have the paten with the particles in his hand" when he says "This is my body" (Sehling 2, p. 309).

The number of hosts on the paten was counted to the number of communicants. The Palatinate (Reformed) wants nothing left over to be reserved (above). Württemberg in 1562 found the minister in some places repeating the Verba "when there is no more bread and wine on the paten and in the chalice", and in others not (Sehling 16, p. 436).

**Held under the chin.** At the sick communion of Brandenburg (1540) "the priest shall also specially hold the paten cleanly under" as he gives the host (Sehling 3, p. 80). Pfalz-Neuburg (1543) adds "that nothing fall" (Sehling 13, p. 88). The Palatine sick order of 1556 dropped the instruction (editors' note, Sehling 14, p. 111). In the Mass the same office passed to the communion cloth held by two men or boys (§14.6.3).

**Shown, and then not shown.** The paten could be shown to the people with the chalice. Havelberg (1558) insists that the elevation of the sacrament remain, "much less shall the paten be elevated in the stead of the chalice" (Sehling 3, p. 230). Hohenlohe abolished the showing in 1596. **Hohenlohe, *Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien*, 1596** (Sehling 15, p. 659):

> Also auch die monstration belangend patinae et calicis under der recitation verborum coenae achten wir auch, dieweyl brott und wein in der handlung des abendmalls ohne das auf dem altar offentlich aufgestelt sind, das derowegen solche monstratio panis et vmi (weyl es unsere gnedige herrschaft je also haben will) soll eingestelt werden

So also concerning the showing of the paten and the chalice during the recitation of the words of the Supper, we also judge, since bread and wine in the action of the Supper are in any case set out openly on the altar, that therefore such showing of bread and wine (since our gracious lordship will have it so) shall be given up.

Nassau-Weilburg's explanations of 1617 likewise call it "unnecessary that the minister, while he speaketh the words of institution of the holy Supper, layeth hold of the paten and the chalice severally", and order it stopped (Sehling 10, p. 351). At Hof, before Pangratius's time, the deacon of the week broke his large host, "left a particle lying in the paten after the old catholic custom", and after communion dropped it into the chalice (Sehling 11, p. 453).

**In the inventories.** Patens were counted with the chalices:

- Potsdam (1541): "2 patens" beside five chalices; at the chapel of St Gertrude "the patens and vestments are burnt" (Sehling 3, pp. 259–260);
- Oschatz (1555): "8 chalices with their patens" (Sehling 1, p. 628);
- Fürstenberg in Mecklenburg (1578): "two silver gilt patens" (Sehling 5, p. 265; §14.6.6).

The Merseburg visitors of 1544 asked what the church had "in store in patens, monstrances, chalices and other silver" (Sehling 2, p. 12). Other orders charge the church officers with the patens and other treasures:

- the *Altermann* of Ermsleben (1564) hands over "the treasures of chalices, patens, albs, chasubles" to his successors (Sehling 2, p. 488);
- Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) orders the church doors and windows barred "with strong grilles and iron bolts" for the sake of the "chalices, patens and other" treasures (Sehling 13, p. 207);
- the Sponheim visitation order of 1590/91 lists, among the things each church must have, "a chalice and a paten for the communion; a capsule or box for the wafers or hosts; a pewter can, or where needful two, for the wine" (Sehling 18, p. 655).

**The host box.** The particles were kept in a box (*Lade*, *Schachtel*, *Kapsel*): Sponheim and Strasbourg (above; both Lutheran). The *ciborium* for reservation went with the monstrance: Pomerania 1535 needs no ciborium (Sehling 4, p. 342), and Teschen 1584

names "the shutting of the sacrament into the ciborium" among idolatrous ceremonies (Sehling 3, p. 461). Reservation is treated in §14.5.5.

**The Reformed dish.** The Reformed gave up the paten with the chalice:

- **Pfalz-Zweibrücken (1595, Reformed):** all chalices and patens were to be collected and made into beakers (§14.6.5).
- **Ysenburg-Birstein (1598, Reformed):** the ministers are not to use "consecrated chalices, patens and altars", but ordinary bread, broken and given into the hands, and "a clean drinking vessel" for the wine (Sehling 10, p. 645).
- **Wittgenstein (1605, Reformed):** the Mass vestments, patens and chalices are to be sold to advantage and a beaker bought for each place (Sehling 22, p. 149).
- **The dish.** In its place the bread was carried in a dish (*Schüssel*). Micron's London order (Reformed), printed with the Emden orders, passes the dishes with the bread among those sitting at the table (editors' comparison of the Supper forms, Sehling 7/1, p. 576). The Lutheran Marienhafe order of 1593 also names "table cloth, chalice, dish and can" for the Supper (Sehling 7/1, p. 710).

**Not found.** No order regulates the paten's material or size, or the veil and burse that go with it. None mentions the paten's use at the offertory, or the minister's wiping of it.

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## 14.7 Vestments

### 14.7.1 The Mass vestment kept

**Allstedt 1533.** In Electoral Saxony the Lutheran visitors restored the Mass vestment where radicals had dropped it. At Allstedt, where Müntzer (Radical Reformation) had celebrated in a surplice or in ordinary clothes, pastors are to wear alb and chasuble "as is now done at Allstedt and also at Wittenberg", with two burning lights. These ceremonies serve good discipline and do no harm. **Allstedt, *Ordnung der Visitatoren*, 1533** (Sehling 1, p. 510):

> So auch etzliche bisanher ohne alben und casulen in einem korock, auch etzliche in schlechten kleidern mes gehalten, sollen sie furthin alben und casulen, wie itz zu Alstedt auch zu Wittenberg und anderswo gehalten wird, auch gebrauchen, darzu zwei brennende licht unter messen auch haben, dann diese ceremonien, welche zu ordnung guter zucht, dienen und unschedlich sein

Since also some until now have held Mass without albs and chasubles in a surplice, and some also in plain clothes, they shall henceforth also use albs and chasubles, as is now kept at Allstedt and also at Wittenberg and elsewhere, [and] have also two burning lights during Mass besides; for these ceremonies, which serve for the order of good discipline and are harmless …

**Leisnig 1529.** At Leisnig, where for six years the pastors had consecrated "without surplice and Mass vestment, simply in the coat", every pastor in the whole district is to use the Mass vestment whenever he consecrates, conforming to Torgau and Wittenberg. **Leisnig, *Verordnung der Visitatoren*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 605):

> die pfarrer und jenigen, so dem volk das sacrament geraicht, ane korrock und messgewand siecht im rock consecrirt, ist ernstlich bevolen, das forthin alle pfarrer nicht allein zu Leisnik sunder im ganzen kreis messgewand und andere unschedliche cerimonien, so oft sie consecriren, brauchen, und allenthalben nach dem buchlen der visitator, auch dem angefangnem brauch der kirchen zu Torgau und Wittemberg sich gleichformig machen sollen.

[whereas] the pastors and those who have reached the sacrament to the people have consecrated without surplice and Mass vestment, simply in the coat, it is earnestly commanded that henceforth all pastors, not only at Leisnig but in the whole district, use the Mass vestment and other harmless ceremonies as oft as they consecrate, and everywhere conform themselves to the booklet of the visitors and to the begun use of the churches at Torgau and Wittenberg.

**Calenberg 1544/45.** The Calenberg synods order the chasuble and two lights and abolish the elevation, for uniformity and "for the simple and weak's sake". **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Synodalkonstitutionen*, 1544/1545** (Sehling 6/2, p. 868):

> setzen demnach und ordenen, das die celebratio coenae dominicae nicht anders, dann in der ordenunge vermeldet, gehalten, die elevatio gar abgeschafft, die mesgewender oder casel angezogen und 2 liechte auf den altar gesetzt werden sollen, nicht, das an solchen ceremonien etwas sonderlichs gelegen sey, sonder das wir gerne eine gleicheit und ehrbarkeit umb der einfeltigen und schwachen willen

[we] appoint therefore and ordain that the celebration of the Lord's Supper be held no otherwise than is set forth in the order; the elevation wholly abolished; the Mass vestments or chasuble put on; and two lights set upon the altar: not that anything special lieth on such ceremonies, but that we would gladly [have] a uniformity and seemliness for the simple and weak's sake.

**Wolfenbüttel 1569.** The Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel order requires the ministers, when there are communicants, to come to the altar "not only in their customary clothes" but in their church ornaments. **Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, p. 143):

> pastores und kirchendiener, so messe halten wöllen, wenn communicanten vorhanden sein, nicht bloß mit ihren gewönlichen kleidern, sondern in ihrem ornatu ecclesiastico, als alben, caseln und meßgewand fein ehrlich und mit grosser andacht und anruffung des Sons Gottes vor den altar tretten und das officium missae anfahen, halten und verrichten.

pastors and ministers who will hold Mass, when communicants are present, [shall] step before the altar not merely in their customary clothes but in their church ornaments, as albs, chasubles and Mass vestment, finely and honestly and with great devotion and calling upon the Son of God, and begin, hold and perform the office of the Mass.

**Grubenhagen 1544.** Grubenhagen orders alb and chasuble and lights at the Sacrament, "to the honour of the sacrament", and the surplice for all other offices in church. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1032):

> III. Vom kleyde und lichtern, die man zum sacrament gebrauchen sol. Und in solcher administrirung der heiligen sacramenta solen die pfarhern dem sacrament zu ehren alven und kassel anziehen und licht auf dem altar brennen, auch in deutsche sprache die episteln und evangelia mit einem gewonlichen accentu singen, aber ausserhalbe dem ampte in der kirchen sollen der pfarher und opperman ihre korrock anhaben und gebrauchen.

III. Of the clothing and lights which one shall use for the sacrament. And in such administering of the holy sacraments the pastors shall, to the honour of the sacrament, put on alb and chasuble and [have] lights burn upon the altar, and also sing the epistles and gospels in the German language with a customary accent; but outside the office in the church the pastor and the sexton shall have on and use their surplices.

Thorn 1575 has the priests minister "in the customary church clothes, chasuble and surplice" (§14.6.3), and Thüngen 1564 keeps the Mass vestment for peace (§14.3.3). Hildesheim 1544 keeps vestments and lights but leaves stole and maniple free (§14.3.3).

**Riga 1530.** The Riga order makes the variation itself a lesson in freedom: a plain surplice on Sundays, a cope or chasuble over it on high feasts, since there are still plenty of them, "that one may see that neither this nor that is needful". **Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 5, p. 17):

> Auf die fest aber, mag er ein chorkappe oder casel (die weil ihr noch genug verhanden ist, und doch sonst, wiewol sie viel gelt gekost haben, da verterben) schlecht über das röckel ziehen, auf das durch solche stete verwandlung und enderung die freiheit solcher eusserlichen ding, destebas vermerckt werd, auf das man sehe, das wider dis noch jens nötig sei, und das eben so wenig an schwarze oder blaue röckel, als wenig als an chorröckel oder chormentel oder casel, die freiheit des evangeliums gebunden

But on the feasts he may simply draw a cope or chasuble over the little surplice (since there are still enough of them, and otherwise, though they have cost much money, they spoil there), that by such constant change and alteration the freedom of such outward things may be the better perceived; that one may see that neither this nor that is needful, and that the freedom of the gospel is bound as little to black or blue coats as to surplices or copes or chasubles.

**Kurland 1570.** Kurland follows Riga: a white linen garment or surplice at the altar, any festal vestment allowed on high feasts, none in the pulpit. **Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 99):

> demnach sollen die priester nach altem, löblichen, gebliebenem gebrauch dieser kirchen für dem altar, wenn sie des sontags oder zu andern zeiten die communion halten, in einem weissen, leinen kleide oder chor röcklein verkleidet, dem altar dienen [...] Wenn man aber auf die obnangezeigten hohen festen zur verendrung andere seitgewant, caseln, mesgewand, priesterliche kleidung und dergleichen wil für dem altar gebrauchen, ist auch niemands verboten. Auf der canzel aber sol man keine verkleidung, darum das es in diesen landen nach der Rijgischen kirchenordnung ungewöntlich, gebrauchen.

therefore the priests, according to the old, laudable, remaining use of this church, shall serve the altar before the altar, when they hold the communion on Sunday or at other times, clad in a white linen garment or little surplice [...] But if on the aforesaid high feasts one will use before the altar, for a change, other silken vestments, chasubles, Mass vestment, priestly clothing and the like, it is also forbidden to no one. But in the pulpit one shall use no vesting, because it is unaccustomed in these lands according to the Riga church order.

#### 14.7.2 The cope when there is no communion

Where there were no communicants, several orders forbade the chasuble, so that the people should not think the private Mass had returned. The minister wore a cope or a surplice instead. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 77):

> so sol der priester nit in gewonlichem meßgewand, sonder in einem chormantel oder nur in seinem chorrock für den altar treten und es aller ding halten, wie oben gesetzt ist

then the priest shall step before the altar not in the customary Mass vestment, but in a cope or only in his surplice, and keep all things as is set above.

**Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 71):

> Es sollen auch, wenn solche empter gehalten werden, die priester kein casula, sondern allein ein korkappen oder auf den dörfern, do die korkappen nicht weren, ein schlechten korrock anhaben, damit das einfeltig volk nicht auf voriger meinung bleib oder geleitet werde, als wolt man die mess nach voriger weiss mit der communion on communicanten widerum anheben und halten

The priests also, when such offices are held, shall have on no chasuble, but only a cope, or in the villages, where there were no copes, a plain surplice; that the simple people abide not in, nor be led into, the former opinion, as though one would begin and hold again the Mass after the former manner, with the communion without communicants.

**Schwäbisch Hall 1527.** Brenz allows the deacon a cope at the common prayer, so that church vesture be not wholly rejected, but not a Mass vestment, "for it is neither a man's nor a woman's clothing". **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 50):

> Und das die kirchencleydung nit gar verworffen werde, mocht der diaconus, so sich bezimen wolt, des gebets ernst und herlichait zuerzaigen, ain Cormantel anlegen, wie bißhieher zu vesper und metten gewont war, aber nit ein meßgewandt, dan es kein mans noch weybs claidung ist, sonder zu gar nerrisch anzusehen vor der gemeinen versamlung.

And that church vesture be not wholly rejected, the deacon, if it would beseem him to show forth the earnestness and majesty of the prayer, might put on a cope, as hitherto was the custom at Vespers and Matins; but not a Mass vestment, for it is neither a man's nor a woman's clothing, but altogether too foolish to look upon before the common assembly.

#### 14.7.3 Vestments abolished

**Dalmatic and tunicle.** The Homberg synod of 1526 (Moderate Reformed) forbids the vestments of deacons and subdeacons outright, since it will not favour orders without warrant in God's word. **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

> [24] Dalmaticas, hoc est papisticorum diaconorum vestes aut subdiaconorum nemo de caetero induat. Nolumus enim favere ordinibus illis sine Dei eloquiorum testimoniis

[24] Dalmatics, that is, the vestments of the papistical deacons or subdeacons, let no one put on henceforth. For we will not favour those orders without the testimonies of the oracles of God.

**Regensburg 1554.** The fullest statement of reasons in the corpus is Regensburg's, written by Nikolaus Gallus to be read from the pulpit, on why the "Levite and Mass vestments" are to go. First, both come from the Levitical priesthood and the papal Mass. **Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554** (Sehling 13, p. 432):

> Ein ehrbar rat hat sampt uns dienern des worts für gut angesehen, das die leviten- und meßgewand bei der communion in unser christlichen kirchen alhie wie bei vielen andern hinfort genzlich abgetan sein sollen. Dasselbig aus

> nachvolgenden ursachen: Erstlich, das beide stück (wie zum teil die namen noch anzeigen) vom levitischen priestertum des alten testaments und von des bapsts messe in unser kirchen kommen und ihre bedeutung auf den zukünftigen Christum gehabt haben.

An honourable council together with us ministers of the word hath thought good that the Levite and Mass vestments at the communion in our Christian church here, as with many others, shall henceforth be wholly put away. The same for the following causes: First, that both pieces (as the names in part still show) have come into our church from the Levitical priesthood of the Old Testament and from the pope's Mass, and have had their signification upon the Christ to come.

Second, the pope still requires them as necessary. Third, they hinder the simple and make it look as if there were little difference between the papal and the evangelical service. Anyone still offended after so many years of teaching "is hardly any more to be counted among the weak". The surplice stays, but only as a mark of the minister. **Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554** (Sehling 13, p. 433):

> Doch lassen wir leviten- und meßgewand also fallen, das wir noch zur zeit den chorrock lassen bleiben, wie wir ihn bisher haben behalten aus freiem willen weder umb des bapstes oder interims willen noch, das er ichts zum gottesdienst nötig sein sölte, sondern allein zu unterscheid der diener, dieweil sie da im ampt stehen und zwischen der andern gemeine

Yet we let the Levite and Mass vestments so fall, that we still for the time let the surplice remain, as we have kept it hitherto of free will, neither for the pope's nor for the Interim's sake, nor that it should be anything needful to the service of God, but only for a difference of the ministers, while they stand there in office, and the rest of the congregation.

The Regensburg order of [1567] repeats the reasons and adds the stole and the lights. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 480):

> Demnach haben wir auch die kirchenkleidung, als meßgewand, stolen, leviten usw. gleich wie auch die liechter, so von anfang der reinen lere gleichwol lange zeit in unser pfarrhe mit gehalten worden, entlich sampt den obgemelten, etlichen feiertägen lassen fallen aus ursachen, das die ding aus dem alten testament von dem levitischen priestertum, so sein ende hat, mit unverstand sind in das neue testament eingefürt und in eitel bapstisch abgötterei gewendet.

Accordingly we have also at last let fall the church vesture, as Mass vestment, stoles, Levite [vestments], etc., even as also the lights, which nevertheless from the beginning of the pure doctrine were kept a long time in our parish, together with some of the aforesaid feast days, for the causes that these things were brought without understanding out of the Old Testament, from the Levitical priesthood, which hath its end, into the New Testament, and turned into mere popish idolatry.

**Transylvania 1557.** The Hermannstadt synod holds that burning candles, *infulae* and ornaments, though indifferent in themselves, have ceased to be indifferent because so many churches have cast them out as popish dregs. They are to be laid aside in time, once the people are taught. A seemly white linen garment without images may serve instead. **Hermannstadt, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 1557** (Sehling 24, p. 262):

> Incensio candelarum, infulae et ornatus, etiam si res mediae sint et per se neque prosint neque obsint, tamen cum plurimae ecclesiae eas ut feces Papisticas abiecerint et nunc sine scandalo retineri non possint ac in numero rerum mediarum propter hoc accidens esse desierint, successu temporis, ubi populus edoctus fuerit, verum usum sacramenti non in ista specie externa et fulgente consistere [...] abiici debent. Cum autem sine aliquo decoro speciali haec actio sacra et gravissima peragi non possit, linea veste alba decente, carente idolis id fieri potest, ut ex primitivae ecclesiae testimonio manifestum est.

The burning of candles, *infulae* and ornaments, even if they be indifferent things and of themselves neither profit nor hurt, yet since very many churches have cast them away as popish dregs, and they cannot now be retained without offence, and by this accident have ceased to be in the number of indifferent things, ought to be cast away in course of time, when the people shall have been taught that the true use of the sacrament consisteth not in that outward and shining show [...]. But since this sacred and most weighty action cannot be performed without some special seemliness, it may be done in a seemly white linen garment, void of images, as is manifest from the testimony of the primitive church.

*Infula* here most likely means the chasuble, as in other Transylvanian and Hungarian usage, not the mitre.

**Others.** The Sayn synod of 1575 drops the Mass vestment and keeps the surplice (Sehling 19/1, p. 356). Anhalt 1596 (Reformed) orders "Mass vestment and chasubles" laid aside (§14.5.2), and the Lutheran Sponheim 1590/91 turns them into altar cloths

(§14.6.1).

### 14.7.4 The surplice

**The minimum.** Where nothing else survived, the surplice (*Chorrock*) usually did. It is the vestment most often named in the corpus, and the reasons given for it are always the same: to distinguish the minister in office from the congregation, and to keep the service seemly. Duke Albrecht's Prussian ordinance of 1543 forbids any pastor to preach, baptize or give the sacraments without at least a white surplice. **Prussia, *Befehl*, 1 February 1543** (Sehling 4, p. 60):

> kein predig thun, taufen oder sacramenta reichen, es sei dann, sie haben zum wenigsten einen weissen chorrock an, domit dannoch hierinnen auch eusserlich ein weltlicher unterscheid zwischen dem diener des worts, wann er in seinem ambt ist, und einem andern, der nicht darzu berufen, zu sehen.

[shall] do no preaching, baptizing or reaching of sacraments, unless they have on at the least a white surplice, that so herein also outwardly a worldly difference may be seen between the minister of the word, when he is in his office, and another who is not called thereto.

**Hesse 1532** (Moderate Reformed). The Hessian order uses the surplice "for the people's sake", to revive a reverence "almost wholly extinguished". **Hesse, *Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 76):

> und, wen es versamlet ist, ists umb des volks willen fur geschickt angesehen (ut vel sic quodam modo plebis reverentiam pene prorsus extinctam alamus), einen chorock zu brauchen

and, when it is assembled, it is thought fit for the people's sake (*that even so we may in some manner nourish the reverence of the common people, almost wholly extinguished*) to use a surplice.

**Württemberg 1535.** The preface to the Württemberg order of 1535 grants that clothing makes no man godly or ungodly, but rules the surplice in for all church offices. It is "not the least outward ornament of the church" that the minister be known by an honest, distinct garment. Many weak believers had been put off the gospel by seeing ministers stand "in a stumpy little coat". **Württemberg, *Vorrede zur Kirchenordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 16, p. 133):

> Von der klaidung im kirchenampt. Die kleidung macht an ir selbs weder frum noch unfrum unnd wurdt under die freyen stuck gezelet. […] so soll fürohin alwegen in den kirchen emptern der Chorrock gebraucht werden. Dan dieweyll alles in der kirchen zierlich und ordenlich zu ghen soll, so ist es nicht die geringst eusserlich kirchen zier, das der jenig, so im brauch des kirchenampts vor der gemeinen kirchen versamblung stheet, bey einem erbarn underschidlichen claid erkennet werde. Darzu ists offenbar, das vill schwach glaubige on andere ursach, auch von wegen diser ursach, das sie den kirchendienern on biß anher gewonliche kirchen cleidern allein in einem stumpfen rocklin in den emptern sehen sthen, ein mercklich abscheuhen von der predig des hailgen evangelium, auch von brauch der sacramenten uber komen.

Of the clothing in the church office. Clothing of itself maketh neither godly nor ungodly, and is reckoned among the free things. […] so shall henceforth the surplice be used always in the church offices. For since all things in the church should go comely and in order, it is not the least outward ornament of the church that he who standeth before the common assembly of the church in the exercise of the church office be known by an honest, distinct garment. Moreover it is manifest that many weak in faith, for no other cause but this cause also, that they see the ministers standing in the offices without the hitherto customary church clothes, only in a stumpy little coat, have gotten a notable abhorrence of the preaching of the holy gospel and also of the use of the sacraments.

The great Württemberg order of 1553 confirms it "until our further decision". **Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553** (Sehling 16, p. 266):

> So mögen wir leiden, das die kirchendiener in allen ämptern, so sie in der kirchen verrichten sollen, den gwonlichen Chorrock biß auff ferner unsern bescheid gebrauchen und sonst auch in allweg sich einer ehrlichen, gebürlichen kleidung fleissigen, damit nicht allein ir wort und predig, sonder auch ir kleidung, weiß und geberde ein leer der tugendt seien.

So may we suffer that the ministers in all offices which they are to perform in the church use the customary surplice until our further decision, and otherwise also in every way study an honest, seemly clothing, that not only their word and preaching but also their clothing, manner and bearing may be a teaching of virtue.

**The Cellische Ordnungen 1545.** The Albertine Saxon ordinances of 1545 make it a rule of clerical discipline. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 302):

> 2. In ubunge gotlicher ampter in der kirchen söllen die priester allewege ein chorrock anhaben, dan es sol in der kirchen decenter venuste et honeste zugehen.

2. In the exercise of divine offices in the church the priests shall always have on a surplice, for in the church things shall go decently, comely and honestly.

**Wittgenstein 1563.** Wittgenstein leaves the old vestments free but keeps the surplice "with one accord", since a minister should be somewhat distinguished from others in his clothing. **Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563** (Sehling 22, p. 97):

> Dieweil es aber gleichwoll billich und ehrlich ist, das ein kirchendiener sein ampt züchtig vor der gemeine verrichte und in der kleidung von andern etwas underschieden werde, soll man den chorrock darzu eintrechtiglich erhalten und brauchen. Und sollen die pastores sampt den kirchenmeistern versehung thun, das die gebreuchliche kirchen ornamenta bestellet und sauber gehalten werden.

But since it is nevertheless meet and honest that a minister perform his office modestly before the congregation and be somewhat distinguished from others in his clothing, one shall keep and use the surplice thereto with one accord. And the pastors together with the churchwardens shall take order that the customary church ornaments be provided and kept clean.

**Anhalt 1568.** In Anhalt the surplice is worn at all three Sunday sermons and may be left off on weekdays. **Anhalt, *Abschied* of Prince Bernhard, 1568** (Sehling 2, p. 570):

> desgleichen soll des sontags zu allen dreien predigten der chorrock gebraucht, die wochen uber auch nachgelassen werden.

likewise the surplice shall be used on Sunday at all three sermons, and over the week also be let go.

**Limited.** In Ernestine Saxony after 1554 the surplice was dropped in the pulpit but kept at the altar. **Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction* of the dukes, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 224):

> idoch solle der chorock auf der canzel zugebrauchen in alwege und an allen orten durchaus abgeschaft, aber von dem altar unter der sacrament raichung nochglassen werden

yet the use of the surplice in the pulpit shall be abolished in every way and in all places throughout, but at the altar during the reaching of the sacrament be permitted.

Coburg in the same year limits it to the communion, worn only by the one who celebrates. **Coburg, *Vorschaffung*, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 544):

> Zum sechsten der chorock sol wider zu den begrebnussen noch auf der canzel noch sonsten in andern kirchenampten, sondern allain zur communion von der ainigen person welche das ampt heldet, gebraucht werden.

Sixthly, the surplice shall be used neither at burials nor in the pulpit nor otherwise in other church offices, but only at the communion, by the one person who holdeth the office.

**Abolished.** The Palatine Calvinists abolished the surplice with the communion cloth at Amberg in 1567 (Reformed), and the Lutheran Upper Palatine visitation of 1579 dropped both again under Ludwig VI (§14.6.3). The Sayn consistory did the same in 1582, in the same protocol that orders the remaining images removed (Sehling 19/1, p. 377).

**The black gown.** The Wild- und Rheingrafschaft order of 1603 is the only order found that prescribes a black gown. Each minister is to have a black church gown with sleeves made "at the first opportunity" and wear it in his office. White surplices are to be kept where they are in use, without superstition, and not abolished without the count's knowledge. **Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 19/2, p. 630):

> Beßonders aber wollen wir, daß jeder unßerer kirchendiener erster gelegenheit nach ihme ein schwartzen kirchenrock mit ermeln zeuge und in verrichtunge seines ampts anziehe. Waß aber die weiße chorröck anlangett, wo dieselbige in unßern kirchen in usurpantz und gebräuchlich sein, da soll man solche ohn superstition oder aberglauben behalten und ohn unßer vorwißen nit abschaffen.

But especially we will that each of our ministers at the first opportunity get himself a black church gown with sleeves, and put it on in the performing of his office. But as for the white surplices, where the same are in practice and use in our churches, there shall one keep them without superstition or superstitious belief, and not abolish them without our knowledge.

#### 14.7.5 What the orders do not mention

The orders never mention the amice, cincture, maniple (except to leave it free at Hildesheim), tunicle (except under "Levite vestments"), humeral veil, rochet, biretta, zucchetto, galero, pallium, rationale, episcopal gloves, tippet or hood, nor any preaching bands. No evangelical order provides a mitre or crosier, and none prescribes liturgical colours (§14.6.6). See §14.2.3.

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### 14.8 Clerical dress outside the service

**Long priestly coats.** The orders want the minister to be recognisable in the street as well as in church. Grubenhagen 1544 adds to its rule on vestments (§14.7.1) that pastors are otherwise to go in long priestly coats. **Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1032):

> Sonsten sollen sie in zimlichen, ehrlichen, langen pristerlichen rocken oder kleydungen ghan und nicht hertretten wie landsknechte und andere wilde junge leute.

Otherwise they shall go in seemly, honest, long priestly coats or clothing, and not stride along like soldiers and other wild young people.

The Albertine ordinances of 1545 give the same rule more fully. **Albertine Saxony, *Die Cellischen Ordnungen*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 302):

> 1. Die priester söllen eherliche lange cleider tragen, nicht also verkürzt und verstummelt, wie die leichtfertigen leute einher gehen, auch nicht zur schnitten ader bunte kleider tragen und in götlichen ampten keine ausgeschnittene schue tragen, die do ergerlich seind.

1. The priests shall wear honest long clothes, not so shortened and docked as the light-minded folk go about, nor wear slashed or coloured clothes, and in divine offices wear no cut-out shoes, which are offensive.

**To be known.** Regensburg [1567], which kept the surplice so that ministers in office might be known, adds that "outside the office also they should have their honest, priestly clothing for distinction's sake". **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567]** (Sehling 13, p. 481):

> auch darumb, das die kirchendiener, wenn sie in ihrem ampt sind, in und für der andern gemein dester mehr erkent werden, wie sie sonst auch außer dem ampt unterscheids halben ihre ehrliche, priesterliche kleidung haben söllen.

also for this cause, that the ministers, when they are in their office, may be the more known in and before the rest of the congregation, as they should also otherwise, outside the office, have their honest, priestly clothing for distinction's sake.

The Wild- und Rheingrafschaft order of 1603, which introduced the black gown (§14.7.4), says the same. **Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603** (Sehling 19/2, p. 630):

> Dann obwohl die kleidung in der kirchen, auch außerhalb derselben, keinen menschen weder heiliger noch unheiliger machen, jedoch weil alles ehrlich unndt zierlich zugehen soll, demnach wollen wir, daß unßere kirchendiener in undt außer ihrem ampt sich also mit kleidung tragen, daß dem ansehen deß ministerii und kirchendieners, so viel möglich, nichts benohmen werde.

For although clothing in the church, and also outside it, maketh no man either holier or unholier, yet because all things should go honestly and comely, therefore we will that our ministers, in and outside their office, so bear themselves in clothing that nothing be taken from the dignity of the ministry and of the minister, so far as is possible.

Württemberg 1553 asks the same "honest, seemly clothing", so that the ministers' dress, manner and bearing may be "a teaching of virtue" (§14.7.4). Riga 1530 reminds them that the gospel is not bound to "black or blue coats" any more than to surplices (§14.7.1).

**Related.** Freiberg 1537 abolishes "wearing tonsures [and] cowls" among the merely human ordinances, and Brunswick 1528 wants no tonsure and no special coat for deacons (see Chapter 16, §16.3.3).

The conduct required of ministers and their households is treated in Chapter 15, §15.3.3.

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## 14.9 Table by order

**Key.**

- The orders are listed by date.
- "—" means that nothing on the point was found in the passages examined. It does not mean that the order forbids it.
- Each cell reports only what the order itself says. The § column gives the sections of this chapter where the evidence is quoted or cited.

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1522 | 1 | Images removed | Three altars without images enough | — | — | 14.5.1 |
| Strasbourg, mandate, 1525 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | No removal of images, altars, panels without the council | — | — | — | 14.4.2 |
| Pomesania, *Themata*, 1525 | 4 | Not to be prayed to; no lights before them | — | — | — | 14.4.1 |
| Prussia, *Artikel der ceremonien*, 1525 | 4 | — | Customary font kept | — | — | 14.5.6 |
| Luther, *Deutsche Messe*, 1526 | 1 | No covering of images, hunger cloth or palm-shooting in Holy Week | — | — | — | 14.4.1, 14.6.6 |
| Hesse, Homberg synod, 1526 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | — | Candles commended; no reservation in ambries; no Candlemas blessing of candles | No new paraments, chasubles or copes; chasuble free; seemly chalice | Surplice at least; dalmatics and tunicles forbidden | 14.3.3, 14.5.4, 14.5.5, 14.6.4, 14.7.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall (Brenz), 1527 | 17/1 | — | — | — | Deacon may wear a cope at prayer, never a Mass vestment | 14.7.2 |
| Brunswick (Bugenhagen), 1528 | 6/1 | Only worshipped images removed by | — | Lights and banners at baptism needless | — | 14.4.1, 14.4.6 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | authority; histories stay | | | | |
| Mülhausen, Holy Week opinion, [1528] (Reformed) | 20/2 | Good Friday crucifix showing dropped | Sepulchre, clappers and altar washing dropped | — | — | 14.6.6 |
| Schmiedeberg, visitation, 1528 | 1 | — | — | Two chalices and three best vestments kept; albs to the hospital; rest sold | — | 14.6.4 |
| Breslau, *Schul- und Kirchenordnung*, 1528 | 3 | — | — | Black funeral cloths for a fee | — | 14.6.6 |
| Colditz, visitation, 1529 | 1 | — | Altars arranged for the minister to face the people | — | — | 14.5.2 |
| Leisnig, visitation, 1529 | 1 | — | — | — | Mass vestment restored whenever consecrating | 14.7.1 |
| Riga, *Kirchenordnung*, 1530 | 5 | — | — | — | Surplice on Sundays; cope or chasuble on feasts, to show freedom | 14.7.1 |
| Ulm, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | Worshipped images removed by officials | — | — | — | 14.4.4 |
| Hesse, *Ordenung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | — | — | — | Surplice for the people's reverence | 14.7.4 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533 | 11 | — | Lights free | Altar covering and vessels free | Mass vestment free | 14.3.1 |
| Allstedt, visitation, 1533 | 1 | — | Before, not behind, the altar; two lights | — | Alb and chasuble restored | 14.5.2, 14.5.4, 14.7.1 |
| Saalfeld, visitation, 1533 | 1 | Banners and idolatrous images removed | All altars but one; screens removed | — | — | 14.4.6, 14.5.1, 14.5.7 |
| Wittenberg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1533 | 1 | — | Schoolboys in the north gallery | — | — | 14.5.7 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bremen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1534 | 7/2.2 | — | Warm water in the font basin in winter | — | — | 14.5.6 |
| Württemberg, preface, 1535 | 16 | — | — | — | Surplice in all offices, as church ornament and for the weak | 14.7.4 |
| Hannover, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 6/2 | Crucifix and honest images kept | Lights on the altar; font; altar | Customary vessels | Customary priestly clothing at the altar | 14.3.1 |
| Württemberg, *Kastenordnung*, 1536 | 16 | — | Endowments for the eternal light to the common chest | — | — | 14.5.4 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1536 | 16 | — | Choose the most convenient altar | — | — | 14.5.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Agende*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | — | Altar-table set up facing the people | — | — | 14.5.2 |
| Freiberg, visitation, 1538 | 1 | Crucifix carried before every funeral | — | — | — | 14.4.5 |
| Brandenburg, *Kirchen-ordnung*, 1540 | 3 | — | Blessing of lights and herbs dropped | Sick chalice, corporal, pall | Cope or surplice, no chasuble, without communicants | 14.5.4, 14.6.2, 14.7.2 |
| Neumark, *Kasten-Ordnung*, 1540 | 3 | — | Each guild to keep a window and give wax for winter lights | — | — | 14.5.4, 14.5.7 |
| Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung*, 1542 | 2 | — | No sacrament or lamps in the sacrament house | — | — | 14.5.5 |
| Prussia, *Befehl*, 1543 | 4 | — | — | — | No preaching or sacraments without at least a white surplice | 14.7.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13 | Image plays of the feasts abolished | No blessing of Candlemas wax, paschal candle or Easter fire; Holy Week Matins without din | — | Cope or surplice, no Mass vestment, without communicants | 14.5.4, 14.6.6, 14.7.2 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 11 | Luther's view; uncertain histories removed by authority | Lights left; Candlemas sermon against the lights | — | — | 14.4.1, 14.5.4 |
| Grubenhagen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1544 | 6/2 | Crucifix in mid-church and panels over altars kept; all else removed | Side altars, candlesticks, banners, screens removed | — | Alb, chasuble, lights at the Sacrament; surplice otherwise; long coats | 14.4.2, 14.7.1, 14.8 |
| Hildesheim, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1544 | 7/2.1 | — | Lights explained by the night of the Supper | — | Vestments kept until all agree; stole and maniple free | 14.3.3, 14.5.4 |
| Nördlingen (Löner), 1544 | 12 | — | Font railed and adorned | — | — | 14.5.6 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen synods, 1544/45 | 6/2 | — | Two lights; elevation abolished | — | Chasuble | 14.7.1 |
| Albertine Saxony, *Cellische Ordnungen*, 1545 | 1 | — | — | — | Surplice always in church; long clothes, no slashed or coloured | 14.7.4, 14.8 |
| Nuremberg, Dietrich's *Agendbüchlein*, 1545 | 11 | Crucifix at the deathbed not evil; the word the best crucifix | — | — | — | 14.4.5 |
| *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545 | 1 | — | Against standing behind the table | — | — | 14.5.2 |
| Kurpfalz, *Gemaine maß*, 1546 | 14 | — | One lamp only | Paten with the hosts taken in hand at the Verba | — | 14.5.4, 14.6.7 |
| Ansbach, *Auctuarium*, 1548 (Interim order) | 11 | — | Altar candles lit throughout Mass and Vespers | — | — | 14.5.4 |
| Mecklenburg, visitation, 1552 | 5 | Images nailed to the walls; banners and crosses removed | All altars but the high altar; ciboria removed | — | — | 14.4.2, 14.4.6, 14.5.1 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15 | Image plays abolished | No reservation | Silk cloth held by two men; | — | 14.4.6, 14.5.5, |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | | kneeling benches | | 14.6.3, 14.6.6 |
| Regensburg (Jonas), 1553 | 13 | — | — | Deacons in surplices hold the cloth | — | 14.6.3 |
| Württemberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 16 | — | — | — | Surplice until further notice; honest dress | 14.7.4, 14.8 |
| Coburg, *Vorschaffung*, 1554 | 1 | — | — | — | Surplice only at communion | 14.7.4 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction*, 1554 | 1 | — | — | — | Surplice not in the pulpit, kept at the altar | 14.7.4 |
| Regensburg, reasons, 1554 | 13 | — | — | — | Levite and Mass vestments abolished; surplice kept | 14.7.3 |
| Gotha, visitation, 1555 | 1 | Non-biblical images not suffered | Altars arranged for facing the people | — | — | 14.4.1, 14.5.2 |
| Lüneburg, *Reformatio coenobiorum*, 1555 | 6/1 | — | No blessing of palms, Easter candles, water or fire | — | — | 14.5.4 |
| Henneberg, Römhild, 1556 | 2 | — | — | Covers for altar, pulpit, font from old vestments; pall | — | 14.6.1 |
| Upper Palatinate, instruction, 1557 | 13 | Removed by night; carved taken out, painted blacked over | All altars but one | — | — | 14.4.2, 14.5.1 |
| Speyer, *Kirchenordnung*, 1557 | 19/1 | — | — | Two boys hold the cloths | — | 14.6.3 |
| Hermannstadt, synod, 1557 | 24 | Fabulous images removed; sacred histories kept | Candles to be laid aside | — | *Infulae* and ornaments laid aside; white linen garment | 14.4.2, 14.7.3 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, visitation, 1558 | 18 | — | Nuns' choir screen torn away | — | — | 14.5.7 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, visitation, 1560 | 13 | — | Sacrament houses and unused altars | — | — | 14.5.5 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | | removed | | | |
| Anhalt, *Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande*, 1562 | 2 | Crucifix kept in honour | Altar and font kept clean | White linen or tapestries | Mass vestment kept | 14.4.5, 14.6.1 |
| Suhl, *Ordnung des predigamts*, 1562 | 2 | — | Sunday service with communion held without lights | — | — | 14.5.4 |
| Kurpfalz, mandates, 1562 (Reformed) | 14 | — | Young people not to set up May branches | — | — | 14.6.6 |
| Heidelberg Catechism, 1563 (Reformed) | 14 | Images not to be suffered as laity's books | — | — | — | 14.4.4 |
| Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1563 | 22 | — | — | Ornaments kept clean | Old vestments free; surplice kept | 14.7.4 |
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1 | — | Fonts before the choir, raised a step or two | — | — | 14.5.6 |
| Thüngen, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 11 | Idols removed; scriptural histories kept as laity's Bible | Candles kept for peace | — | Mass vestment kept for peace | 14.3.3, 14.4.1 |
| Hermannstadt, synod, 1565 | 24 | — | Altars not to be pulled down; restored | — | — | 14.5.1 |
| Leiningen-Westerburg, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1566 | 19/1 | Banners not to be carried | May branches and decking the church with flowers forbidden | — | — | 14.6.6 |
| Kurpfalz, *Befehl*, 1565 (Reformed) | 14 | Altars, crucifixes, Mounts of Olives removed | Sacrament houses, fonts, stoups removed | — | — | 14.4.4 |
| Amberg, mandate, 1567 (Reformed) | 13 | — | — | Communion cloth abolished | — | 14.6.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, [1567] | 13 | Middle way: histories kept, lying images removed; covered Coronation of Mary removed | Lights dropped | — | Mass vestment and stole dropped; surplice kept; priestly dress outside | 14.4.1, 14.6.6, 14.7.3, 14.8 |
| Prussia, *KO und Ceremonien*, 1568 | 4 | Against Calvinist | — | — | — | 14.4.4 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | image-storming | | | | |
| Anhalt, Prince Bernhard, 1568 | 2 | — | — | — | Surplice at all Sunday sermons | 14.7.4 |
| Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung*, 1569 | 6/1 | — | Clean cloths and lights on the altar | — | Albs and chasubles with communicants | 14.5.4, 14.7.1 |
| Kurland, *Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5 | New paintings of resurrection and Judgement | One altar; two candles and a pulpit light; fine font | Two chalices; font towels and cloths | White linen or surplice; festal vestments free; none in the pulpit | 14.4.3, 14.5.1, 14.5.4, 14.5.6, 14.6.5, 14.7.1 |
| Hadersleben, pew mandate, 1571 | 23 | — | Pews rebuilt to clear the aisle | — | — | 14.5.7 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1 | Scriptural histories kept with profit | — | — | — | 14.4.1 |
| Wolfstein, Stieber's *Instructio*, 1574 | 13 | Crucifix before funerals allowed | — | — | — | 14.4.5 |
| Sayn, synod, 1575 | 19/1 | — | — | — | Mass vestment dropped; surplice kept | 14.7.3 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1575 | 4 | — | — | Boys hold silk cloths | Chasuble and surplice | 14.6.3, 14.7.1 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 | 10 | — | Sacrament houses and ossuaries removed | — | — | 14.5.5 |
| Mecklenburg, visitation of Fürstenberg, 1578 | 5 | — | Two brass candlesticks on the altar | Silver-gilt chalices and patens; linen for the altar | Red-and-green and red velvet chasubles; red damask deacon's coats | 14.6.6 |
| Lichtenberg, instruction, 1579 | 18 | Images and crucifixes removed | — | — | — | 14.4.4 |
| Salzwedel, visitation, 1579 | 3 | — | Guilds to repair their windows | — | — | 14.5.7 |
| Upper Palatinate, visitation, 1579 | 13 | — | — | Communion cloth dropped | Surplice dropped | 14.6.3 |
| Saxony, *Ordnung*, 1580 | 1 | — | No pews without leave; mischief on galleries | — | — | 14.5.7 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Siegen, mandate, 1581 (Reformed) | 10 | Images and panels removed | Altars and organs removed; table | Beaker for chalice | — | 14.5.3, 14.6.5 |
| Marggrabowa and Sensburg, *Gottesdienstordnungen*, 1581 | 4 | — | Altar lights lit when there are communicants | — | Mass vestment with communicants; surplice otherwise | 14.5.4 |
| Sayn, consistory, 1582 | 19/1 | Remaining images removed | — | — | Surplice abolished | 14.7.4 |
| Magdeburg, *Instruktion*, 1583 | 2 | Worshipped images removed | Sacrament houses removed; lights as each church has them | Altar cloths as each church has them | Mass vestment and surplice as each church has them | 14.3.2 |
| Mansfeld, consistorial order, 1586 | 2 | Crucifix and Bible on the oath table | Two candles | Black pall with white cross | — | 14.4.5 |
| Kurpfalz, Casimirian mandate, 1587 (Reformed) | 19/2 | — | Wooden tables for altars; no font | One chalice kept, silver beakers | — | 14.5.3, 14.6.5 |
| Gottorf, *Visitationsartikel*, 1587 | 23 | — | Visitors ask whether candles are lit or removed | — | Linen and silk vestments: in use or abolished? | 14.5.4 |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1588 (Reformed) | 22 | — | Fonts moved out of the corners | — | — | 14.5.6 |
| Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, 1590/91 and 1607 | 18 | Crucifix and images removed | Old fonts and altars to be cleared out | Surplices and vestments made into altar cloths | — | 14.4.4, 14.5.6, 14.6.1 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11 | — | Grass and May branches for the dedication procession | — | — | 14.6.6 |
| Marienhafe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1593 | 7/1 | — | "Altar or table" | Table-cloth, chalice, dish and can | — | 14.5.3 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, mandate, 1595 (Reformed) | 18 | — | — | Chalices and patens melted for beakers | — | 14.6.5 |
| Hohenlohe, *Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien*, 1596 | 15 | — | — | Showing of paten and chalice at the Verba stopped | — | 14.6.7 |

| Order | Vol. | Images and crucifix | Altar, lights, font, building | Paraments and vessels | Vestments | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Sorau, *Kirchenordnung*, 1595 (extract) | 3 | — | — | Boys hold the communion cloths | Boys in red smocks with green garlands | 14.6.6 |
| Anhalt, Johann Georg, 1596 (Reformed) | 2 | Panels and carved crucifixes removed | Behind the table; lights laid aside; table for altar | — | Mass vestment and chasubles laid aside | 14.5.2, 14.7.3 |
| Simmern, mandate, 1598 (Reformed) | 19/2 | Idol-work removed | Altars and fonts abolished; tables | — | — | 14.5.3 |
| Wild- und Rheingrafschaft, 1603 | 19/2 | — | — | — | Black gown with sleeves; white surplices kept where used | 14.7.4, 14.8 |
| Leiningen-Hardenburg, visitation, 1609 | 19/1 | — | — | Altar, font, pulpit and desk to be covered | — | 14.6.1 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte*, 1617 | 10 | No crucifix before corpses | — | Communion cloth abolished | — | 14.4.5, 14.6.3 |

## 14.10 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §14.9 and the text.

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine Saxony | *Die Cellischen Ordnungen* | 1545 | 1, p. 302 | 14.7.4, 14.8 |
| Allstedt | *Ordnung der Visitatoren* | 1533 | 1, p. 510 | 14.7.1 |
| Anhalt | *Abschied* of Prince Bernhard | 1568 | 2, p. 570 | 14.7.4 |
| Anhalt | *Kirchenordnung auf dem Lande* | 22 July 1562 | 2, p. 562 | 14.4.5 |
| Anhalt (Reformed) | *Verordnung Johann Georgs* | 3 November 1596 | 2, p. 580 | 14.5.2 |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg (Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1588 | 22, p. 268 | 14.5.6 |
| Brandenburg | *Kirchen-ordnung* | 1540 | 3, pp. 71, 80 | 14.6.2, 14.7.2 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1533 | 11, p. 183 | 14.3.1 |
| Bremen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1534 | 7/2.2, p. 439 | 14.5.6 |
| Brunswick | *Kirchenordnung* | 1528 | 6/1, p. 445 | 14.4.1 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel | *Kirchenordnung* | 1569 | 6/1, p. 143 | 14.5.4, 14.7.1 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen | *Synodalkonstitutionen* | 1544/1545 | 6/2, p. 868 | 14.7.1 |
| Coburg | *Vorschaffung* | 1554 | 1, p. 544 | 14.7.4 |
| Colditz | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1529 | 1, p. 545 | 14.5.2 |
| Ernestine Saxony | *Instruction* of the dukes | 1554 | 1, p. 224 | 14.7.4 |
| Freiberg | *Visitation Verordnung und Artikel* | 1538 | 1, p. 468 | 14.4.5 |
| Gotha | *Artikel der Visitatoren* | 1555 | 1, p. 569 | 14.5.2 |
| Gottorf | *Visitationsartikel* | 1587 | 23, p. 371 | 14.5.4 |
| Grubenhagen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1544 | 6/2, pp. 1032, 1034 | 14.4.2, 14.7.1, 14.8 |
| Hadersleben | *Mandat zu den Kirchenstühlen* | 31 May 1571 | 23, p. 242 | 14.5.7 |
| Hannover | *Kirchenordnung* | 1536 | 6/2, p. 1009 | 14.3.1 |
| Henneberg | *Abschied der Visitatoren für die Superintendenz zu Römhild* | 20 December 1556 | 2, p. 328 | 14.6.1 |
| Hermannstadt | *Synodalbeschlüsse* | 1557 | 24, p. 262 | 14.4.2, 14.7.3 |
| Hermannstadt | *Synodalartikel* | 1565 | 24, p. 293 | 14.5.1 |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed) | *Homberger Kirchenordnung* | 1526 | 8, pp. 45, 46, 49 | 14.3.3, 14.5.4, 14.5.5, 14.6.4, 14.7.3 |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed) | *Ordenung der Christlichen kirchen* | 1532 | 8, p. 76 | 14.7.4 |
| Hildesheim | *Christlike kerckenordeninge* | 1544 | 7/2.1, p. 852 | 14.3.3, 14.5.4 |
| Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim | *Kirchen- und Zensurordnung* | 1590/91 | 18, p. 653 | 14.6.1 |
| Hohenlohe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1553 | 15, p. 71 | 14.6.3 |
| Hohenlohe | *Verbesserungen der Kirchenzeremonien* | 1596 | 15, p. 659 | 14.6.7 |
| Kurland | *Kirchenordnung* | 1570 | 5, pp. 87, 98, 99 | 14.4.3, 14.5.4, 14.7.1 |
| Kurpfalz | *Gemaine maß, die kirchen- und gottesdinst anzurichten* | 1546 | 14, pp. 94, 97 | 14.5.4, 14.6.7 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Heidelberger Katechismus*, Question 98, *Kirchenordnung* | 1563 | 14, p. 362 | 14.4.4 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Casimirianische Kirchenordnung*, mandate | 1587 | 19/2, p. 757 | 14.5.3 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Amberger Mandat* | 20 January 1567 | 13, p. 303 | 14.6.3 |
| Kurpfalz (Reformed) | *Befehl an die Amtleute* | 3 October 1565 | 14, p. 429 | 14.4.4 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Leiningen-Hardenburg | *Visitations- und Täuferordnung* | 1609 | 19/1, p. 315 | 14.6.1 |
| Leiningen-Westerburg | *Kirchenzuchtordnung* | 1566 | 19/1, p. 227 | 14.6.6 |
| Leisnig | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1529 | 1, p. 605 | 14.7.1 |
| Lichtenberg | *Dienstanweisung für die Pfarrer* | 1579 | 18, p. 379 | 14.4.4 |
| Lüneburg | *Reformatio coenobiorum* | 1555 | 6/1, p. 615 | 14.5.4 |
| Lüneburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 6/1, p. 554 | 14.5.6 |
| Magdeburg | *Instruktion zur Visitation* | 25 May 1583 | 2, p. 424 | 14.3.2 |
| Mansfeld | *Form und weise … mit den öffentlichen eidesleistungen*, appended to the consistorial order | 1586 | 2, p. 214 | 14.4.5 |
| Marggrabowa | *Gottesdienstordnung* | 1581 | 4, p. 149 | 14.5.4 |
| Marienhafe | *Kirchenordnung* | 1593 | 7/1, p. 710 | 14.5.3 |
| Mecklenburg | *Visitations-Instruction* | 12 November 1552 | 5, p. 220 | 14.4.2 |
| Mecklenburg | *Ordnung der Visitatoren für Fürstenberg* | 1578 | 5, p. 265 | 14.6.6 |
| Mülhausen (Reformed) | *Gutachten zu den Gottesdiensten in der Karwoche* | [1528] | 20/2, p. 207 | 14.6.6 |
| Nassau-Weilburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1576 | 10, p. 310 | 14.5.5 |
| Nassau-Weilburg | *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung* | 1617 | 10, pp. 351, 353 | 14.4.5, 14.6.3 |
| Neumark | *Kasten-Ordnung* | 1 March 1540 | 3, p. 32 | 14.5.4, 14.5.7 |
| Nuremberg | *Agendbüchlein Veit Dietrichs* | 1545 | 11, p. 522 | 14.4.5 |
| Nördlingen | *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners* | 1544 | 12, p. 314 | 14.5.6 |
| Oldenburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1083 | 14.4.1 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1543 | 13, pp. 77, 96 | 14.6.6, 14.7.2 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | *Visitationsordnung* | 1560 | 13, p. 135 | 14.5.5 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken | *Visitationsordnung* | 1558 | 18, p. 270 | 14.5.7 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Reformed) | *Mandat zur Ablieferung der Vasa sacra* | 7 April 1595 | 18, p. 410 | 14.6.5 |
| Pomesania | *Themata episcopi Risenburgensis* | 1525 | 4, p. 29 | 14.4.1 |
| Prussia | *Artikel der ceremonien und anderer kirchen ordnung* | 10 December 1525 | 4, p. 33 | 14.5.6 |
| Prussia | *Befehl* | 1 February 1543 | 4, p. 60 | 14.7.4 |
| Prussia | *Kirchenordnung und Ceremonien* | 1568 | 4, p. 73 | 14.4.4 |

| Order | Title | Date | Sehling | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas* | 1553 | 13, p. 421 | 14.6.3 |
| Regensburg | *Kirchenordnung* | [1567] | 13, pp. 480, 481 | 14.4.1, 14.6.6, 14.7.3, 14.8 |
| Regensburg | *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden* | 29 April 1554 | 13, pp. 432, 433 | 14.7.3 |
| Riga | *Kirchenordnung* | 1530 | 5, p. 17 | 14.7.1 |
| Saxony | *Ordnung Herzog Augusts* | 1580 | 1, p. 451 | 14.5.7 |
| Schmiedeberg | *Verordnung der Visitatoren* | 1528 | 1, p. 664 | 14.6.4 |
| Schwäbisch Hall | *Kirchenordnung* | 1527 | 17/1, p. 50 | 14.7.2 |
| Schönburg | *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger | 18 October 1542 | 2, p. 175 | 14.5.5 |
| Simmern (Reformed) | *Mandat zur Abschaffung der Bilder und Altäre* | 2 October 1598 | 19/2, p. 661 | 14.5.3 |
| Sorau | *Kirchenordnung*, extract after J. S. Magnus | 1595 | 3, p. 372 | 14.6.6 |
| Speyer | *Kirchenordnung* | 1557 | 19/1, p. 92 | 14.6.3 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Agende* | 1537 | 20/1, p. 270 | 14.5.2 |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed) | *Mandat über Bilder und Altäre* | 18 March 1525 | 20/1, p. 166 | 14.4.2 |
| Suhl | *Ordnung des predigamts und lektionen* | 1562 | 2, p. 351 | 14.5.4 |
| Thorn | *Kirchenordnung* | 1575 | 4, p. 237 | 14.6.3 |
| Thüngen | *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | 11, pp. 736–737, 739 | 14.3.3, 14.4.1 |
| Ulm (Moderate Reformed) | *Kirchenordnung* | 1531 | 17/2, p. 145 | 14.4.4 |
| Upper Palatinate | *Visitationsinstruktion* | 1557 | 13, p. 297 | 14.4.2 |
| Upper Palatinate | *Visitationsordnung* | 1579 | 13, p. 315 | 14.6.3 |
| Wild- und Rheingrafschaft | *Kirchenordnung* | 1603 | 19/2, p. 630 | 14.7.4, 14.8 |
| Wittenberg | *Kirchen-Ordnung* | 1522 | 1, p. 697 | 14.5.1 |
| Wittenberg | *Kirchen-Ordnung* | 1533 | 1, p. 704 | 14.5.7 |
| Wittgenstein | *Kirchenordnung* | 1563 | 22, p. 97 | 14.7.4 |
| Wolfstein | *Christliche Instructio des Thomas Stieber* | 1574 | 13, p. 586 | 14.4.5 |
| Württemberg | *Vorrede zur Kirchenordnung* | 1535 | 16, p. 133 | 14.7.4 |
| Württemberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1536 | 16, p. 107 | 14.5.1 |
| Württemberg | *Kastenordnung* | 1536 | 16, p. 96 | 14.5.4 |
| Württemberg | *Kirchenordnung* | 1553 | 16, p. 266 | 14.7.4 |

# Chapter 15. Ecclesiastical Duties

This chapter sets out what the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth century, printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*, required of each estate in the church. It asks:

- **Clergy.** What were pastors and deacons, superintendents, members and presidents of consistories, and professors of theology expected or required to do?
- **Training.** How were ministers trained: school, university and stipend, practice preaching, examination, a probationary period, and continuing study after ordination?
- **Laity.** What did the orders require of ordinary church members: attendance, prayer at home, confession and communion? Were sextons, schoolmasters and other church workers held to a higher standard?
- **Schoolmasters.** What were their church duties?
- **The magistrate.** What were the prince's and the council's duties towards the church?
- **Catechesis.** How often was the catechism taught, and for how long? What did it require? Was first communion separate from confirmation, and did each require instruction? Did any order give communion to infants? Was there catechesis or counselling before marriage?

**How the chapter is laid out.**

- §15.1 answers each question in brief, and §15.2 sets out the scope, the sources and the negative findings.
- §§15.3–15.6 cover the clergy:
  - §15.3, pastors and deacons;
  - §15.4, superintendents and deans;
  - §15.5, consistories, their presidents and members;
  - §15.6, professors of theology.
- §15.7 covers the training of ministers.
- §15.8 covers the laity and the church workers.
- §15.9 covers schoolmasters, and §15.10 the magistrate.
- §15.11 covers catechesis, where all the estates meet: its frequency and length, first communion, confirmation, instruction before marriage, and infant communion.
- §15.12 is a table by order, and §15.13 a concordance of every order quoted.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- preaching and the catechism sermon: Chapter 11;
- the daily office and the obligations of clergy and students to it: Chapter 10, §10.6;
- confirmation, marriage, ordination, installation, sextons, schoolmasters and magistrates as rites: Chapter 13, §§13.6, 13.7, 13.10–13.13;
- deacons, elders and the minor offices: Chapter 16;
- the oaths and confessional subscriptions of ministers: Chapter 17;
- clerical dress: Chapter 14, §14.8;
- the catechism service, its hour, length and order: Chapter 10, §10.10;
- private confession and the examination of communicants: Chapter 13, §13.17;
- the hearers during the sermon: Chapter 11, §11.12.

## 15.1 Summary of findings

**1. Pastors: preach, administer, catechize, visit, study, and live as an example** (§15.3). The visitation questions sum up the office: preaching, the sacraments, the catechism, weddings, and visiting the sick and sorrowful (Strasbourg 1598). The pastor's other duties:

- **study** a set list of books: the Bible, Luther's postil, Melanchthon's *Loci* and the Augsburg Confession, with copies bought for every parish (Saxony 1557; Hoya 1581);
- **marry**, keep out of taverns and trade, and bring up wife, children and servants as a model household, which the visitors inspected;
- **reside**, never leaving the parish overnight without leave and a substitute (Hoya 1581);

- **keep registers** of baptisms, marriages and burials from mid-century (Saxony 1580).

The deacons had the catechism and the sick as their particular charges, "readier to serve the poor herein than the rich" (Saxony 1555).

**2. Superintendents: visit, hold synod, examine, report** (§15.4). The Saxon pattern of 1555–1557 gives the superintendent four tasks:

- to watch over the doctrine, life and diligence of the pastors;
- to visit unannounced, hearing sermons and examining the youth;
- to hold a synod every year between Easter and Whitsun;
- to examine and install new pastors, and send to the consistory what he cannot mend.

By 1600 the superintendent was sworn to the confessional corpus and acted as the consistory's agent (Grubenhagen). In Transylvania the chapters elected their own deans (Lasseln 1572).

**3. Consistories: theologians and jurists; the president disputed** (§15.5). The consistory judged marriage cases, church discipline "so far as the degrees of admonition" go, the affairs of ministers, and church property (Saxony 1580). The orders differed over who should preside:

- the prince in person (Weimar 1561);
- the superintendent (Jena 1569);
- a nobleman (Dresden 1580);
- a lay councillor, so that the clergy should not seem to "lay hold on the worldly sword … like the Pope" (Regensburg 1588).

The consistories met weekly and were sworn to secrecy.

**4. Professors: no seminaries** (§15.6). No order founds a seminary. Professors of theology appear in the orders as members of consistories, as examiners and ordainers (Wittenberg, Leipzig, Marburg, Helmstedt), as overseers of the stipendiaries, and as public lecturers.

**5. Training: stipend, practice sermon, examination, probation, synod** (§15.7). There was no vicarage year, but training had parts that did similar work:

- stipends for poor students, bound to serve the territory;
- the Tübingen *Stipendium* (1559), where masters preached in the house and were corrected "*in inventione, dispositione oder pronunciatione*" the same day;
- practice sermons in the parish with the pastor's leave (Saxony 1555);
- examination and a trial sermon before ordination, and if needed some weeks of instruction at Wittenberg or Marburg;
- a probation as deacon before a parish, with a re-examination (Palatinate 1564, Reformed), and the new deacons' sermon outlines sent in for criticism after a year (Palatinate 1607, Reformed).

After ordination the synods set reading "that the priests may be moved the more diligently to read and the sooner to buy books" (Nassau 1552). The Reformed monthly convents criticized each member's sermon and disputed theological questions (Palatinate 1571, Reformed).

**6. Laity: attend, pray at home, commune, be examined** (§15.8). Every householder had to bring children and servants to sermon and catechism. Absentees were counted house by house and fined (Nassau-Weilburg 1576). The legal minimum for communion was once or twice a year (Hohenlohe 1588), with Luther's "once or four times" as the ideal. Parents were to teach the catechism at home, and the youth to pray "morning and evening, also before and after meals and at their work" (Dillenburg 1582).

**7. Church workers: a higher standard** (§15.8.4). Sextons, schoolmasters and organists were held to the conduct required of ministers: "like other ministers of the church, of honest and godly conduct, no drunkards" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed). They were barred from taverns (Hoya 1581) and questioned at visitation about their own communion. The minister's wife, children and servants were inspected with him.

**8. Schoolmasters: the catechism as primer** (§15.9). The schoolmaster taught the catechism, used it as the reading book, led the boys to sermon and catechism, led the singing, and was visited four times a year by the pastor (Esslingen 1534, Moderate

Reformed; Saxony 1555, 1580). In the towns schoolmistresses brought the girls (Palatinate 1595, Reformed).

**9. The magistrate: keeper of both tables** (§15.10). The Lutheran magistrate was to "uphold both tables of the Ten Commandments … in maintaining outward discipline" (Mecklenburg 1552). He was the "defender and nourisher" of churches and schools (Transylvania 1572). In practice he:

- ordered visitation;
- appointed and paid ministers;
- enforced attendance;
- punished what the church could only admonish;
- in the Palatinate (1599, 1608, Reformed), refused citizenship and marriage to those who did not know the catechism.

The Reformed limited his office to "the body and temporal goods" (Hanau 1609, Reformed).

**10. Catechesis: how often, how long, and what it required** (§15.11).

- **Rhythm:** a weekly Sunday catechism of about half an hour, quarterly fortnight-long series (Saxon visitations 1529), a yearly examination in Lent, and house-by-house examinations.
- **Requirement:** the text of the five or six chief parts by heart, and enough understanding to "pray and give a fair account of the chief articles" (Saxony 1555).
- **Before first communion:** at Hohenlohe (1578), children of about twelve were taught "every day for an hour" from Invocavit to Palm Sunday.

**11. First communion and confirmation: usually one act** (§15.11.3). Where the orders have confirmation, the children are "confirmed and admitted to communion for the first time" together (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed). One course of instruction served both. Mansfeld (1580) examined them publicly the day before, monthly. Lauenburg (1585) confirmed twice a year, and Hessen-Kassel (1610, Reformed) heard them again after six months. Where there was no rite, as in Electoral Saxony, examination alone admitted to communion.

**12. Infant communion: acknowledged as ancient, set aside** (§15.11.6). No order gives the Supper to infants or argues for it. Four orders name the practice:

- Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) and Hohenlohe (1578) grant that infants communed in the time of Cyprian and Augustine, but defer the Supper because of 1 Corinthians 11:28 and "the common judgment of the first church". Hesse leaves the old custom "in its worth".
- Oldenburg (1573) says that infants cannot examine themselves or discern the Lord's body.
- The Reformed preacher at Markirch (1561) calls it an error of the ancients, who thought that the uncommunicated were lost.

Children who died before first communion were buried like adults (Regensburg 1572/1588; Henneberg 1582). A dying child who knew the catechism might commune before confirmation (Nassau-Dillenburg 1575, Philippist).

**13. Before marriage: examination, not counselling** (§§15.11.4–15.11.5). From the 1560s many orders refused to proclaim or marry young people who did not know the catechism (Saxony 1580; Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Zweibrücken 1574), "since they are to keep house and get children and servants". Some married them on a pledge, backed if need be by sureties, to attend the catechism afterwards (Wied 1616, Reformed). There was no counselling course. What the orders required was:

- an interview some weeks before, on freedom to marry, parents' consent and the catechism (Limpurg 1610: three weeks);
- confession and communion before the wedding (Schwäbisch Hall 1615; Freudenthal 1592);
- the public exhortation and wedding sermon on the duties of marriage.

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## 15.2 Scope, sources and method

### 15.2.1 Sources and searches

The chapter draws on the full text of the Sehling edition in `eko.db`: the church orders, consistorial and visitation orders, synodal decrees, school and stipend ordinances, and visitation protocols printed with them. The corpus was searched for the vocabulary

of each question, in High and Low German and Latin spellings:

- **Offices:** *Pfarrer*, *Diaconus*, *Kaplan*, *Superintendent*, *Superattendent*, *Inspector*, *Decanus*, *Consistorium*, *Präsident*, *Director*, *Professor*, *facultas theologica*.
- **Training:** *Stipendium*, *Stipendiat*, *Alumnus*, *Probpredigt*, *examen*, *ordinandus*, *Synodus*, *Convent*, *censura*, *studieren*, *Bücher*.
- **Laity:** *Hausvater*, *Gesinde*, *daheim*, *Kirchgang*, *Strafe*, *Küster*, *Opfermann*, *Schulmeister*, *Schulfrau*.
- **Magistrate:** *Obrigkeit*, *custos utriusque tabulae*, *beide Tafeln*.
- **Catechesis:** *Katechismus*, *Kinderlehre*, *Verhör*, *Examen*, *zum ersten Mal* with *Sakrament* or *Nachtmal*, *confirmieren*, and *Katechismus* within a short distance of *Braut*, *Eheleute*, *copulieren*, *aufbieten* or *Hochzeit*.
- **Infant communion:** *kinder*, *kindlein*, *unmündig*, *infantes*, *parvuli* and *pueri* within a short distance of *Nachtmal*, *Abendmahl*, *Sakrament*, *coena* or *communio*; *prüfe sich selbst* and *probet se ipsum* near *Kinder*; *Cyprian*, *Augustin* and *alte Kirche* near *Kinder*; *Böhmen*, *Picarden* and *Hussiten*.

Each hit was read in its context. Pages were checked against Sehling's running heads, which often correct the database's record headings. Among the corrections:

- the Mansfeld agenda quoted is of 1580, though its record is dated 1562;
- the Schwäbisch Hall passages on marriage belong to the revision of 1615, not the order of 1543;
- the consistory order of 1608 is Ysenburg-Birstein's (Reformed), and the deacons' rule of 1550 is Breslau's;
- the Palatine passages (Reformed) on probation and convents are from the *Kirchenratsordnung* of 1564 and Wenzel Zuleger's report of 1571, though their record is dated 1585.

#### 15.2.2 What was not found

- **No seminary.** No order founds an institution for training ministers apart from the universities, the stipend houses and the Latin and cloister schools. The word *seminarium* occurs only in the old sense of a "nursery" of church and state.
- **No vicarage year.** No order prescribes a fixed period of practical training under a pastor before ordination. The nearest equivalents are practice preaching (§15.7.2), the probation as deacon (§15.7.4), and Wittenberg's "some weeks" of instruction (§15.7.3).
- **No continuing-education requirement in hours or courses.** Continuing study was enforced through synods, convents, assigned reading and visitation questions (§15.7.5).
- **No premarital counselling course.** Instruction before marriage meant an examination in the catechism and in the freedom to marry, and often confession and communion. The teaching on marriage itself was given publicly in the wedding exhortation and sermon (§15.11.5).
- **No paedocommunion.** No order gives the Supper to infants or defends the practice, and none mentions the Bohemian communion of infants. The orders that name it treat it as an ancient custom now set aside (§15.11.6).
- **No separate confirmation course.** Where confirmation existed it coincided with first communion, and one instruction served both (§15.11.3).
- **No prayer rule for lay church workers.** The lay offices had duties of conduct and attendance, not of prayer. The daily office bound schools and convents, not sextons (§15.8.4).

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## 15.3 Pastors and deacons

#### 15.3.1 The office in a list

**The visitation questions.** The orders rarely define the pastor's office in the abstract. They list what the visitors are to ask about, and those lists are the best summary of what was expected. Strasbourg's order of 1598 puts the whole office in one sentence and then turns to the minister's life and household. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598** (Sehling 20/1, p. 689):

> Soll derwegen bei der Kirchen Visitation gehandelt werden: 1. Von der Kirchendiener (es seie deren an jedem Orth einer oder mehr) offentlichem Ampt und Befelch, Ob sie denselben mit gebürendem Fleiß und Trew verrichten, Als mit Predigen, Sacramenta reichen, Catechismum halten, Hochzeiten einsegnen und Krancke und Betrübte besuchen und trösten und anderm dergleichen, 2. Von ihrem, der Kirchendiener, Leben und Wandel, Auch von ihrer Haußhaltung, Weib, Kinder und Gesinde,

Therefore at the visitation of the church there shall be dealt with: 1. The public office and charge of the ministers of the church (whether there be one or more of them in each place), whether they perform the same with due diligence and faithfulness, as with preaching, giving the sacraments, holding the catechism, blessing weddings, and visiting and comforting the sick and the sorrowful, and other such things; 2. Their life and conduct, the ministers', and also their housekeeping, wife, children and servants.

The same headings recur everywhere: preaching (Chapter 11), the sacraments and the occasional rites (Chapter 13), the catechism (§15.11 below), the sick, and the minister's own life. The daily office laid no breviary obligation on the parish pastor (Chapter 10, §10.6.5).

### 15.3.2 Study and the pastor's books

**A reading list.** The Saxon General Articles of 1557 name the books every pastor must read: the Bible, Luther's postil, Melanchthon's *Loci*, and the Augsburg Confession with its Saxon *Repetition* of 1551. The elector had a copy of the confessions printed for every parish, to stay in the church's inventory. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

> Sie sollen ihr weib und kind zur zucht und erbarkeit ziehen, aller unehrlichen hantierungen, auch wein - oder bierschenkens, kaufmanschaft und dergleichen hendel sich enthalten, auf der canzel die leute ex affectu nicht schmehen, ires studii und ambts warten, und sonderlich neben der biblia die postillen Lutheri, locos theologicos Philippi lateinisch oder deutsch, die augspurgische confession sampt derselben obbemelten repetition sollen sie oft und fleissig lesen, und alle ire predigten und lehr auf dieselben confessionen und declarationen gründen und richten, damit einerlei form und eintrechtigkeit in der lehr in s. churf. g. landen erhalten, und auf die nachkommenden gepflanzt werde

They shall bring up their wife and children in discipline and honesty, abstain from all dishonest dealings, also from selling wine or beer, from merchandise and such trades, not revile the people in the pulpit *ex affectu*, wait upon their study and office; and especially, besides the Bible, they shall read often and diligently Luther's postils, Philip's *Loci theologici* in Latin or German, [and] the Augsburg Confession together with its aforesaid Repetition, and ground and direct all their sermons and teaching upon these same confessions and declarations, that one form and concord in doctrine may be kept in his Electoral Grace's lands and planted for those that come after.

**Books bought by the parish.** Where a pastor was too poor to buy them, the parish bought them. Hoya in 1581 orders the churchwardens to provide "a good Wittenberg Bible, Doctor Luther's postils and catechisms", the parish making up any shortfall, "that such books may be bought for the church and remain there" (Sehling 6/2, pp. 1140–1141). The pastor's private study was an item of visitation: the Limpurg visitation order of 1611 asks "what writings and books he readeth, and what his private studies be", and the visitor is to exhort him to study if he is found idle (Sehling 16, p. 627). Synods set reading for the year ahead (§15.7.5).

### 15.3.3 Life, household and conduct

**An example to the flock.** The same Saxon articles require ministers and schoolmasters to be "right and pure in doctrine" and blameless in life, to marry, and to keep out of taverns. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

> so wollen s. churf. g. das beide kirchen - und schulen - diener vornemblich in der lehre richtig und reine sein, auch sonsten in irem leben und wandel sich beide in worten, werken und kleidunge erbarlich gegen menniglich, freundlich, züchtig und demütig, und in summa allenthalben und in allem christlich und also vorhalten, das sie menniglich, und sonderlich ihren schul- und kirchen-kindern nicht anstössig, sondern dermassen mit gutem exempel Vorgehen, das die pfar-kinder und sonsten menniglich denselbigen mit lust und frucht seliglichen und ane ergernis folgen mügen, hiezu dann vornemblich dienen würde, da sie zu vormeidunge menschlicher uppigkeit und heraus folgenden Verdachts sich in den heiligen ehestand begeben, [...] ires ampts und studirens fleissig abwarteten, saufens, spaciren - gehens und anderer ergerlichen leichtfertigkeit, auch aller taberneu und schenk - heuser enthielten

his Electoral Grace will that both ministers of churches and of schools be above all right and pure in doctrine, and otherwise in their life and conduct, both in words, works and clothing, behave themselves honestly towards every man, friendly, chastely and humbly, and in sum everywhere and in all things christianly, and so that they be no stumbling block to any man, and especially

to their school- and church-children, but go before with so good an example that the parishioners and every man else may follow them blessedly with delight and fruit and without offence. Whereto it would chiefly serve that they, to avoid human wantonness and the suspicion that followeth from it, enter into holy matrimony, […] wait diligently upon their office and study, [and] abstain from drinking, from walking abroad and other offensive frivolity, and from all taverns and ale-houses.

The articles allow a pastor to sell by the cask the wine or beer of his own glebe or tithe, "only that they hang out no tavern sign nor set guests to drink in the house" (Sehling 1, p. 322). Their dress is treated in Chapter 14, §14.8.

**The household inspected.** The minister's wife, children and servants were visited with him. The Württemberg visitation order of 1559 tells the special superintendent to find out "whether the ministers instruct their children in prayer and the catechism, and keep their boys at school or teach them themselves at home", and to ask each pastor about the "doctrine, life and housekeeping" of his colleagues and neighbours "and of their wives and children" (Sehling 16, p. 387). A Württemberg visitation order of 1547 gives the reason from 1 Timothy 3: "he that ruleth not his house well, how shall he rule the house of the Lord?" (Sehling 16, p. 151). The Oldenburg visitation articles of 1609 ask the parish "how the pastor's wife and children behave themselves towards divine service and live" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1192).

#### 15.3.4 Residence and records

**Residence.** A pastor was not to leave his parish overnight without leave and a substitute. **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1140):

> Derhalben befehlen wir allen und jeden unsern pfarherrn, schulmeistern und küstern, das sich niemand lange von seinem kaspel und ampt, es sey eine oder mehr nacht, ohne nötige ursach begebe und habe von unsern verordneten inspectorn ein jeder in seinem eingesetzten ampt verlaub genommen und eine tüchtige und wolbekante person aus seiner nachbarschaft in unser graffschaft in seinem abwesen gefördert und bestellet.

Therefore we command all and every one of our pastors, schoolmasters and sextons that none betake himself long from his parish and office, be it one night or more, without needful cause, and [unless] each have taken leave of our appointed inspectors in his appointed office, and have procured and appointed a fit and well-known person out of his neighbourhood in our county [to serve] in his absence.

Marienhafe in East Frisia copied the rule in 1593 (Sehling 7/1, p. 728). In the towns the deacons needed the pastor's leave, as at Breslau in 1550 and Regensburg in 1556 (Sehling 3, p. 418; 13, p. 443).

**The parish register.** From mid-century the pastor kept registers of baptisms, marriages and burials, and the visitors inspected them. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 397):

> Damit man auch gewiss sein möge, das ein jeder pfarrer in seiner kirchen vermög unser ordnung die neugetauften kinder, sampt ihrer eltern und paten namen, auf welchen tag sie getauft, desgleichen auch der neuen eheleut namen, auf welchen tag sie getrauet und hochzeit gehalten, auch welchen tag ein jeder verstorben, verzeichnis und register halte, sol der visitator, so oft er visitieret, ihme solches buch, darein es alles ordentlich verzeichnet, vorbringen lassen

And that it may be certain that every pastor in his church, according to our order, keepeth a list and register of the newly baptized children together with their parents' and godparents' names, on what day they were baptized, likewise of the names of the new married folk, on what day they were wedded and held their wedding, and also on what day each one died, the visitor, as often as he visiteth, shall have that same book, wherein all this is orderly written, brought before him.

The register was to stay with the church and not leave with the pastor or his widow. Nassau-Weilburg (1576) adds confirmations (Sehling 10, p. 307), and some orders add the communicants (Kapellendorf 1569, Sehling 1, p. 583). In Pirna (1578) the sexton kept the book, and at Regensburg (1572) he kept the register of the dead (Sehling 1, p. 645; 13, p. 509).

#### 15.3.5 Deacons and chaplains

**The assistant ministers.** The *Diaconus* or *Kaplan* was an ordained assistant (Chapter 16, §16.5.1). His particular charges were the catechism and the sick. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 315):

> Den catechismum sollen sie der jugent vleissig furtragen, und im leren derselben nit ihre kunst und geschicklichkeit beweisen wollen, sundern die kindern lehr dem unverstendigen jungen volk ufs aller einfeltigst und immer uf einerlei

> form und weiss fursagen, und also wider von ihnen fordern und examinieren. In besuchung der kranken sollen sie willig und unverdrossen sein, und mehr bereit, den armen hierin zu dienen, denn den reichen

They shall diligently set forth the catechism to the youth, and in teaching it not seek to show their art and skill, but say the children's doctrine before the unlearned young folk in the simplest way and always in one form and manner, and so require it again of them and examine [them]. In visiting the sick they shall be willing and unwearied, and readier to serve the poor herein than the rich.

They were to honour and obey their pastor and superintendent and "not belittle them before the congregation, nor practise against them, nor stir up factions" (Sehling 1, p. 315). The deacon was chosen by the pastor together with the council (Sehling 1, p. 323).

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## 15.4 Superintendents and deans

### 15.4.1 The name and the office

**One overseer, many names.** The evangelical orders replaced the bishop's oversight with a superintendent (*Superattendens*, *Inspector*, *Dechant*, *Decanus*, *Propst*). Augsburg in 1537 (Moderate Reformed) justifies the office from the apostolic church and says outright that the titles are one. **Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 55):

> derhalb bei den aposteln und hernacher in den kirchen allweg ain oder gar wenig furnemer ufseher, furgänger, superattendeten oder bischof, welche namen all ainerlai heischen, in jeder gemain verordnet worden send, damit dann nicht alhie durch vil hirten dester ubler gehuetet werde […] In suma: sie sollen allerdingen die höchste sorg und fursehung der gemainen Christi uf in haben, versehen und versorgen.

therefore among the apostles, and afterwards in the churches, there have always been appointed in every congregation one or very few chief overseers, leaders, superattendents or bishops, which names all mean one thing, that here the flock be not the worse kept through many shepherds […] In sum: they shall in all things have upon them, oversee and provide the highest care and provision of the congregation of Christ.

At Augsburg (1537, Moderate Reformed) the office rotated quarterly between the council's president and the senior provost. In the territories it was a standing office. Its installation is in Chapter 13, §13.11.4.

### 15.4.2 Electoral Saxony, 1555–1557: visitation, synod, report

**The Saxon pattern.** The Saxon General Articles of 1557 set out the superintendent's duties that most later Lutheran orders follow:

- watch over "the doctrine, life and diligence" of all pastors and church servants in his district;
- summon the village pastors once a year, and visit unannounced, to hear their sermons, ask the parishioners about their pastor's conduct, examine the youth in the catechism and inspect the schools;
- hold a synod every year;
- admonish privately, and report what he cannot mend to the consistory.

**Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, pp. 320–321):

> Darüber sol ein jeder superattendens nach seiner und der benachbarten pfarherrn gelegenheit alle jar zwischen ostern und pfingsten einen synodum halten, und darzu berufen aus den stedten, flecken und dörfern alle pastores, so in seine superattendents gehören, und sich dorinnen irer lahr und sitten, auch anderer vorfallenden gebrechen erkunden, dieselben in besserung richten, insonderheit auch ire relation hören, wie sie ire pfarkinder in examine befunden, und was sie sonst vor irrige sachen anzuzeigen haben, und do etwas fürfiele, das er nicht vorrichten könte, sol er das an das consistorium, dohin die person und sachen gehörig, weisen und gelangen lassen. Do auch der superattendens etwas ungebürlichs oder streflichs von einigem pfarherr in seine superattendents gehörig selbst erfaren, oder aber vom lehenherrn, oder den eingepfarten erkundigung bekommen hette, sol er denselben in geheim darumb ansprechen, und nach gelegenheit der vorbrechunge strafen, mit vorwarnung, do keine besserung folgen, und dergleichen klage mehr für ihn kommen würde, das er solches an das consistorium gelangen lassen müste

Moreover every superattendent shall, as it suiteth him and the neighbouring pastors, hold a synod every year between Easter and Whitsun, and call thereto out of the towns, market towns and villages all the pastors that belong to his superintendency, and therein inquire into their doctrine and manners and other defects that fall out, and bring the same to amendment; and especially hear their report, how they have found their parishioners in the examination, and what other erroneous matters they have to declare. And if anything fell out that he could not settle, he shall refer it and bring it to the consistory to which the person and matter belong. And if the superattendent himself have learned of anything unseemly or blameworthy in any pastor belonging to his superintendency, or have received information of it from the patron or the parishioners, he shall speak to him about it in secret and rebuke him according to the circumstances of the offence, with warning that, if no amendment followed and more complaints of the like came before him, he must bring it before the consistory.

**Other charges.** The superintendent also:

- examined candidates for a parish before sending them to Wittenberg or Leipzig for ordination (§15.7.3);
- installed new pastors before the altar and charged both pastor and people (Sehling 1, p. 321);
- saw that no pastor was dismissed without his knowledge (Sehling 1, p. 312);
- settled the widow's year and the parish inventory when a pastor died (Sehling 1, p. 312).

The 1555 *Generalia* add a yearly meeting of all the superintendents of the Electoral circle at Wittenberg on the Wednesday after Whitsun, where they reported to the pastor of Wittenberg "as the upper superintendent" (Sehling 1, p. 312). The visitor's travelling costs were refunded on a weekly account sent to the elector "into his own hands" (Sehling 1, p. 311).

### 15.4.3 The superintendent's charge: Grubenhagen, 1600

**An instruction under oath.** The Brunswick consistory's instruction for the superintendent of Grubenhagen, on which he was sworn in 1600, shows the office at the end of the century: guardian of doctrine, visitor, and agent of the consistory. **Grubenhagen, *Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici*, 1600** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1109):

> 1. Das er sich, dem corpori doctrinae Julio und formulae ooncordiae im gesunden verstande durchaus gleichmeißig in thesi et antithesi zu lehren und, das seine untersetzten pfarherrn dergleichen thun mugen, vleisiche aufsicht zu haben verpflichte. […] 4. Das er kein dorf oder hauß von seiner superintendenz eximiret achte, noch jemands mit seiner befohlnen visitation in seinem untergegebenen gezirk praeterire […] 5. Es soll der superintendens keine offentliche sunde oder ärgerliche handel den pastoribus und kirchendienern ubersehen

1. That he bind himself to teach in sound understanding, wholly in accord with the *Corpus doctrinae Julium* and the Formula of Concord, *in thesi et antithesi*, and to keep diligent oversight that the pastors under him may do the like. […] 4. That he hold no village or house exempt from his superintendency, nor pass over anyone in his appointed visitation within the district put under him […] 5. The superintendent shall overlook no public sin or offensive dealing in the pastors and ministers of the church.

He was to change no ceremony without the consistory's ruling, to act always *pro matrimonio* in marriage cases, and to settle small matters with the district governor rather than "trouble the consistory lightly" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1109).

### 15.4.4 Deans of the Transylvanian chapters

**Elected deans.** Among the Transylvanian Saxons the pastors of each chapter elected their own dean (*decanus*). **Transylvania, Statutes of the Chapter of Lasseln, 1572** (Sehling 24, p. 361):

> Officium decani est ecclesiarum et scholarum sua dioecesis agere inspectorem ac pro virili sua parte cavere, ne haereses, schismata morumque vitia pullulent. Deinde publicis invigilare commodis atque conventus indicere fratribus non nisi sufficiente aliqua ingenti causa. Ad haec defendere bonos ac insontes contra quasvis iniurias intra et extra capitulum ipsis illatas. Econtra vero severissime animadvertere in rebelles, ignavos, fucos aut quoquomodo infamiam et sibi privatim et toti fraternitati palam creantes.

The office of the dean is to act as inspector of the churches and schools of his diocese, and to take care to the utmost of his power that heresies, schisms and vices of manners spring not up. Next, to watch over the common good, and to call the brethren to assembly only for some sufficient and weighty cause. Besides this, to defend the good and innocent against all

wrongs done them within and without the chapter. But on the other hand to punish most severely the rebellious, the slothful, the drones, and those who in any way bring disgrace both privately on themselves and openly on the whole brotherhood.

For his pains each brother paid him one florin a year. The chapter also judged marriage cases, "which pious magistrates of old, not without weighty counsel, referred to the ecclesiastical court" (Sehling 24, pp. 361–362).

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## 15.5 Consistories, their presidents and members

### 15.5.1 Composition: theologians and jurists

**A mixed court.** The consistory was a standing court of theologians and lawyers under the prince, for marriage cases, church discipline and the affairs of ministers and church property. Wittenberg's of 1539 had two theologians and two doctors of law, mostly professors of the university (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 306, n. 2). Jena's in 1569 was presided over by the superintendent of Jena, who was to be a doctor of theology. **Saxe-Weimar, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569** (Sehling 1, p. 234):

> Wir ordnen und wollen auch, das in diesem consistorio der superintendens zu Jen, so ein doctor theologiae sein soll, praeses sein, und im zween andere theologi, aus den professorn, oder kirchendienern, und dann zween geschickte gottsfürchtige juristen, und unser amptman daselbst, oder ein ander person vom adel, als assessores zugeordnet werden

We ordain and will also that in this consistory the superintendent of Jena, who shall be a doctor of theology, be president, and that two other theologians, out of the professors or the ministers of the church, and then two able, God-fearing jurists, and our district officer there, or another person of the nobility, be joined to him as assessors.

### 15.5.2 The president: prince, nobleman or councillor

**Who presided.** The orders disagree about who should preside:

- **The prince himself.** At Weimar in 1561 Duke Johann Friedrich made himself "the supreme president" and meant to attend "in our own princely person", with his brothers deputizing (Sehling 1, pp. 230–231).
- **A theologian.** At Jena in 1569 the superintendent presided (above).
- **A nobleman.** Electoral Saxony in 1580 set over its upper consistory at Dresden "an understanding, well-qualified [man] of the nobility as president and director of all the consistories' affairs", with two jurists and two theologians, the court superintendent and the preacher of Dresden (Sehling 1, p. 405).
- **A lay councillor, to keep the clergy from the sword.** Regensburg in 1588 gave the presidency to one of the political members. **Regensburg, *Ordnung des consistorii*, 1588** (Sehling 13, pp. 513–514):

> damit auch disfalls des consistorii autorität gegen allen personen, so für dasselbig erfordert und beschieden, künftiglich, wie sich gebührt und die notturft erfordert, erhalten und die kirchendiener aus dem verdacht gesezt, als solten sie widerumb nach dem weltlichen schwert greifen und wie der pabst in der kirchen ihres gefallens regieren wollen, soll aus den dreien zum consistorio verordneten, politischen, gelehrten männern einem, so propter authoritatem, eruditionem et prudentiam vor andern darzu dichtig erkennt, das präsidentenambt und directorium des consistorii befohlen werden

and that in this respect also the consistory's authority towards all persons summoned and cited before it may henceforth be upheld, as is fitting and need requireth, and the ministers of the church set free from the suspicion that they would again lay hold on the worldly sword and rule in the church at their pleasure like the Pope, the office of president and the direction of the consistory shall be committed to one of the three learned political men appointed to the consistory, who is judged fitter for it than the others *propter authoritatem, eruditionem et prudentiam*.

Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) likewise set "a director among the three political councillors" (Sehling 13, p. 237).

**What the president did.** The director:

- put the business to the members and took the vote, "the *umbfrage*", alternating clerical and lay members at his discretion (Hanau 1612, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 539);
- alone made the proposals, "to avoid confusion and ill-will" (Ysenburg-Birstein 1608, Reformed, Sehling 10, p. 686).

The Saxon president of 1580 also gave each newly examined pastor a formal charge on his office before he was sent to his parish (Sehling 1, p. 380).

#### 15.5.3 The business of the consistory

**Its competence.** Electoral Saxony in 1580 sets out the matters that belonged to the consistory, so that "worldly and church courts be not mixed together". **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 403):

> Erstlich alle ehesachen, wie sie namen haben, welche durch die superintendenten und jedes orts oberkeit auf die ihnen zugestellete ordnung nicht können vorrichtet und verglichen werden. Alle ergerliche sünde und laster an den lerern und zuhörern wider die erste und andere tafel der gebot gottes, allein soviel die gradus admonitionum, und nicht die weltliche strafe belanget, wie solche in den synodis verordnet worden. Alle sachen, die pfarrer, kirchen und schuldiener, vocation, ampt, dienst, leben, wandel, translation, dimission, suspension, handlung und verbrechung belangend, auf mass, wie bei den synodis verzeichnet. Alle sachen, so der kirchen, schulen, hospitaln, und gemeiner kasten güter, lehen, einkommen, nutzung, gebeud, und besserung, darzu der kirchendiener besoldung betreffen.

First, all marriage cases, whatever their names, which cannot be settled and composed by the superintendents and the authorities of each place according to the order given them. All offensive sins and vices in teachers and hearers against the first and second table of God's commandments, so far only as concerneth the degrees of admonition, and not the worldly punishment, as these have been ordained in the synods. All matters concerning pastors, ministers of churches and schools: their calling, office, service, life, conduct, translation, dismissal, suspension, dealings and offences, in the measure set down for the synods. All matters concerning the goods, fiefs, income, use, buildings and repair of churches, schools, hospitals and common chests, and also the salaries of the ministers of the church.

The Saxon upper consistory also had a "general inspection and oversight" of the universities of Leipzig and Wittenberg, the princely schools and the two lower consistories. Books were not to be printed without the consistory's censorship (Sehling 1, pp. 402, 407). Brandenburg-Ansbach (1594) forbade booksellers to sell "new, impure, suspect books" without the consistory's knowledge, and set the president and political councillors over the endowments of churches and schools (Sehling 11, p. 382).

**Sessions and secrecy.** The consistories met weekly:

- Hanau (1612, Reformed): every Tuesday afternoon from one o'clock until evening, with extraordinary sessions at the director's discretion (Sehling 10, p. 538);
- Ysenburg-Birstein (1608, Reformed): every Wednesday afternoon from one until four or five, members arriving late being fined (Sehling 10, p. 685).

Members, secretary and copyists swore to keep the business "in the highest secrecy" (Brandenburg- Ansbach 1594, Sehling 11, p. 385; Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, Sehling 13, p. 240).

### 15.6 Professors of theology

**No seminaries.** No order founds a seminary in the later sense. Ministers were trained at the universities, often on a territorial stipend (§15.7), and the church orders treat the professors of theology only where their work touched the church's government.

**What the orders ask of professors.**

- **Sitting in the consistory.** The Wittenberg and Jena consistories drew on the theology faculty (§15.5.1), and the Prussian consistorial order of 1584 names "the *primarius professor theologiae* at the university" among its three theologians (Sehling 4, p. 123). Because the Saxon consistorials of Leipzig and Wittenberg "each also hath his profession at the high school", their sessions were to be timed "that they be in no way hindered in their lectures, and the youth not neglected in their studies" (Sehling 1, p. 402).
- **Examining and ordaining.** Candidates were examined and ordained at Wittenberg and Leipzig (Saxony 1557, Sehling 1, p. 321), at Marburg before "the teachers of God's word and the professors of holy Scripture" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed, Sehling 8, p. 201), and by the theological faculty of Helmstedt, which was not to keep a candidate more than two days nor take more than two thalers (Gandersheim recess 1601, Sehling 6/2, p. 892).
- **Overseeing the stipendiaries.** The prefect of the Marburg stipendiaries examined them twice a year "in the presence of all the professors of theology, that the examination may have the more weight and the wits be stirred to greater

diligence". **Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 159):

> Zum vierten soll er sie alle, des jars zweimal in beisein aller professoren theologiae examiniren, damit das examen soviel mehr ansehens habe und die ingenia zu großerm vleiß excitirt werden.

Fourthly, he shall examine them all twice a year in the presence of all the professors of theology, that the examination may have so much the more authority, and the wits be stirred up to greater diligence.

- **Lecturing the clergy.** Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel (1543) appointed at the cathedral "a *lector theologiae*, who is charged with nothing else than to read some lessons publicly in holy Scripture" (Sehling 6/1, p. 47). The monks and canons in the monasteries were to hear such lectures every weekday morning and evening, "that afterwards, learned in the word of God, they may be set over churches and schools" (Sehling 6/1, p. 81).
- **The academy and the church.** At Strasbourg the church convent and the academy quarrelled over seats and over "the provision and ordering of the theological lectures and disputations"; an agreement of 1575 settled it (Sehling 20/1, p. 507).

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## 15.7 Training of ministers

### 15.7.1 School, university and stipend

**No seminary, no vicarage.** The orders know nothing of a seminary or of a vicarage year in the modern sense. The path to the ministry ran through the Latin school and the university, and the churches paid for it with stipends:

- **Territorial stipends.** Electoral Saxony raised "the number of our stipendiaries … who shall all be drawn to the service of churches and schools" (1580, Sehling 1, p. 376).
- **Stipends on vacant benefices.** The Saxon visitors of 1540 meant to turn church fiefs into stipends as they fell vacant (Sehling 1, p. 288).
- **Stipends from the old monastic goods.** Nassau in 1546 created stipends of 24 florins a year from surplus church income, for boys of at least seventeen (Sehling 10, p. 88).
- **Boarding colleges.** Württemberg's boys passed from the *Pädagogium* at Stuttgart and the cloister schools to the *Stipendium* at Tübingen (1559, Sehling 16, p. 359). The Reformed Palatinate admitted to its stipend only those found fit in the half-yearly examinations of its four *paedagogia* (1593, Sehling 14, p. 553).

Stipendiaries were bound by a written obligation to serve the territory that paid for them (Württemberg 1559, Sehling 16, p. 364; Hohenlohe 1556, Sehling 15, p. 108).

### 15.7.2 Practice preaching in the stipend: Tübingen, 1559

**Preaching under correction.** The Tübingen *Stipendium* is the nearest thing in the orders to a training house for preachers. After the master's degree each stipendiary heard the theology lectures, studied Greek and Hebrew, and preached in the house until he was called. **Württemberg, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559** (Sehling 17/1, p. 561):

> Es soll ein jeder nach erlangtem gradu Magisterii im Studio Theologiae diser Ordination nach one verzug die Lectiones Theologicas fleissig neben dem studio graecae et hebraicae linguae zuhoren unnd mit predigen im Stipendio sich zu üben verbunden sein, so lang und biß dero einer oder mehr zum Ministerio erfordert würdt.

Every one, after attaining the degree of Master, shall be bound in the study of theology, according to this ordinance, without delay to hear the theological lectures diligently, besides the study of the Greek and Hebrew tongues, and to exercise himself in preaching in the Stipendium, so long and until one or more of them be called to the ministry.

The texts were assigned to them, not chosen. They were to handle them by "an understanding, right and orderly method, according to the precepts of dialectic and rhetoric". The superintendents of the house were to tell a preacher "privately, the same day, after the sermon is held", any faults they found "*in inventione, dispositione oder pronunciatione*" (Sehling 17/1, p. 561). The stipendiaries also kept "their disputations, declamations and exercises of style" in the arts faculty (Sehling 17/1, p. 577). The Coburg synod of 1580 asked for a similar house with "*exercitia disputationum, repetitionum, concionum*" led by *magistri repetentes* (Sehling 1, p. 253).

**Preaching in the parish.** A young man could also practise in a parish pulpit, with the pastor's leave and on showing his sermon first. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 314):

> Do aber ein junger gesell, der sich ' begert zuversuchen und zu üben, umb erlaubniss zupredigen bitten wurde, soll ihm der pfarrer solchs zu lassen, doch also, das ime der junge gesell zuvur jemands schriftlichs zeugnis und seiner furgenomenen predigt concept schriftlich oder mundlich furlege.

But if a young fellow, who desireth to try and exercise himself, should ask leave to preach, the pastor shall allow it him, yet so that the young fellow first lay before him someone's written testimony and the draft of the sermon he purposeth, in writing or by mouth.

Schwäbisch Hall's synod ruled in 1606 that no student of theology "who will exercise himself in preaching" should do so without the dean's consent (Sehling 17/1, p. 191).

### 15.7.3 Examination, trial sermon and instruction before ordination

**The examination.** Before ordination the candidate was examined in doctrine and had to preach. **Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 322):

> Und es sol unter andern der ordinandus vor der ordination gefragt, wo und was er studirt, auch wo und womit er sich zuvor enthalten und genehret habe, endlich auch fleissig examinirt werden in der christlichen lahr, auch einmal oder öfter offentlich predigen, und do befunden, das derselbe an lahr und wandel ungeschickt were, sollen die, so inen gesandt und zu der pfarr berufen haben oder wöllen, schriftlich von dieses ungeschickligkeit berichtet und vorwarnet werden, das sie auf einen andern bedacht sein wollen, der zu solchem pfarrambt tüglich sei.

And among other things the ordinand shall be asked before ordination where and what he hath studied, also where and wherewith he hath before maintained and supported himself; finally also be diligently examined in Christian doctrine, and preach publicly once or oftener. And if it be found that he is unfit in doctrine and life, those that sent him and have called, or would call, him to the parish shall be informed in writing of his unfitness and warned to think upon another who is fit for such a pastoral office.

The trial sermon (*Probpredigt*) became standard. In the Reformed Palatinate it was to show "how he can teach the common people out of Scripture, exhort them to amendment and comfort them", with attention to "his pronunciation" (Kirchenratsordnung 1564, Sehling 14, p. 412). Henneberg sent the candidate to preach before the parish, which reported back "how the man sent pleased them with his person, delivery, bearing [and] repute" (1555, Sehling 2, p. 294).

**Weeks of instruction at Wittenberg.** A candidate who was teachable but not yet fit was not simply rejected. The superintendent was to send him to Wittenberg "with warning that he be provided beforehand by those that called him to the pastorate with needful expenses, that he may be instructed at Wittenberg some weeks, if need be, and await ordination without burdening anyone" (Saxony 1555, Sehling 1, p. 312). Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) told examiners to keep promising candidates at Marburg for a time. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 201):

> So aber die examinatores etlich aus denen, so zum examen gesant und geschickt befunden werden, sollen sie dieselbige vermanen, daß sie ein zeitlang bleiben, die lectiones fleißig visitiren und insonderheit in der heiligen schrift sich wol uben, domit sie mögen hernach zum examen geschickter kommen.

But if the examiners find some of those that are sent to the examination [not yet] fit, they shall exhort them to stay a while, to attend the lectures diligently, and especially to exercise themselves well in holy Scripture, that afterwards they may come to the examination better prepared.

### 15.7.4 Probation: deacon before pastor

**The diaconate as apprenticeship.** The closest thing to a vicarage is the rule that a new man should first serve as deacon under a pastor. **Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 413):

> Und soll keinem neuling, der zuvor im ministerio nit gewesen, leichtlich eine pfarr bevolhen werden, es were dann sach, das einer so geschickt, alt und erfarn, das auß den umbstenden und seinem wesen erschiene, das er ein pfarr versehen kundte, so mag man ime wol eine pfarr vertrauen, sonst aber nit leichtlich, sonder soll zuvor zu einem diacono gebraucht

> und nach etlicher zeit, wann man ime eine pfarr bevelhen wolte, wider examinirt werden, auf das man darauß judiciren möge, ob er in der lere zugenommen

And no novice that hath not been in the ministry before shall lightly be entrusted with a parish, unless one be so able, old and experienced that it appeared from the circumstances and his bearing that he could have charge of a parish; then one may well entrust a parish to him, but otherwise not lightly. Rather he shall first be used as a deacon, and after some time, when one would commit a parish to him, be examined again, that one may judge thereby whether he hath increased in doctrine.

The Palatine *Kirchenratsordnung* of about 1593 (Reformed) repeats the rule (Sehling 14, p. 548). In 1607 the Elector's church council found that "the young *sapientisten* and other new ministers sent out mostly do not increase but decrease". **Palatinate, *Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen*, 1607** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 957):

> Bevelhen demnach, das ihr allen solchen neuen diaconis, wen sie 1 jar in euer inspection geweßen, ihre dispositiones concionum abfordern solt, dieselbige nach obgedachtem ecclesiaste Buccani censurirent, solche eure censuras oben daruf schreiben und sie uns zuschicken, damit auch wir dieselbige, ehe sie alhero citirt werden, leßen, die mängel ihnen daruf undersagen und alßdan solche ihre dispositiones ihnen wieder zustellen können.

We command you therefore that from all such new deacons, when they have been a year in your inspection, you require their outlines of sermons, censure the same according to the aforementioned *Ecclesiastes* of Bucanus, write your censures above them, and send them to us, that we also may read them before they be cited hither, show them their faults therein, and then give them their outlines back.

Elsewhere the new man stood under the eye of his superintendent. Pfalz-Neuburg's consistory kept "a book … wherein every pastor's or minister's name and surname, age, where he studied, how he stood in the examination, [how he] held [himself] in the trial sermon" were written (Pfalz-Neuburg 1576, Sehling 13, p. 172; Hohenlohe 1580, Sehling 15, p. 491).

#### 15.7.5 Continuing study: synods, convents and assigned reading

**Reading set from synod to synod.** The yearly synod was also a school for the pastors. The Saxon superintendent was to give his pastors "a useful little book, or a piece of the Bible, to read this coming year", on which they would hear one another at the next synod (1555, Sehling 1, p. 312). Nassau-Dillenburg in 1552 made the same rule into an examination. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Synodalabschied*, 1552** (Sehling 10, p. 93):

> daß in einem jeden synodo den priestern ein oder mher locos proponiert werden soll, uff den andern nachvolgenden synodum dieselbigen zu repetiren unnd durchaus zu examiniren und alßdan einen andern oder mher zuproponiren, uff den volgenden synodum zu examiniren unnd also forthan, damit die priester desto vleissiger zulesen und desto ehe bucher zukauffen verursacht werden.

that in every synod one or more *loci* shall be set before the priests, to be repeated and thoroughly examined at the next synod following, and then another or more set, to be examined at the following synod, and so forth, that the priests may be moved the more diligently to read and the sooner to buy books.

**Monthly convents with sermon criticism.** The Reformed Palatinate made the convent of the pastors a monthly exercise. The president of the church council reported to the Elector in 1571. **Palatinate, Wenzel Zuleger's report on the classical convents, [1571]** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 446):

> Erstlich ist den kirchen- und schuldienern bevolhen, das sie alle monat einmal uf iren kosten sollen an bestimpten orten zusamenkhommen. Doselbst soll einer auß inen ein locum scripture teutsch in conventu predigtweiß erkleren. Wan solchs geschehen, soll er abtreten, di andere kirchendiener urtheilen, ob er di meinung deß texts recht verstendtlich und erbeulich dargeben, auch di lehr, vermanung und straf daraus recht und zu erbauung angezogen. Wo er gefelt, soll im das freundtlich undersagt und zur beßerung ermanet werden. Hernach soll durch den praesidem […] ein par quaestiones theologicas proponiren, sie latine under sich oder theutsch, wo es erbeulich, tractiren

First, the ministers of churches and schools are commanded to come together once every month, at their own cost, at appointed places. There one of them shall expound a passage of Scripture in German in the convent, after the manner of a sermon. When this is done he shall withdraw, and the other ministers judge whether he hath set forth the meaning of the text rightly, understandably and edifyingly, and drawn from it doctrine, exhortation and rebuke rightly and to edification. Where he

faileth, he shall be told so in a friendly way and exhorted to amend. After that the president [...] shall propose a couple of theological questions, [which] they [shall] handle among themselves in Latin, or in German where it is edifying.

The later Palatine and Hanau convent orders (1607, 1609, both Reformed) turned this into a full procedure, with the pastors bound by oath to "submit willingly to the censure of my brethren" (Sehling 14, p. 609; 10, p. 542).

**Trial sermons for serving pastors.** In Brandenburg the village pastors took turns preaching trial sermons at the weekday service in the town church, besides the yearly convents, "that they may be better informed in the articles of faith and the controversies of religion … and have occasion for more diligence in the study of doctrine" (visitation recess of 1600, Sehling 3, p. 212). At Neuruppin in 1558 the rural pastors were, in Sehling's summary, to be summoned, examined and made to preach once a quarter (Sehling 3, p. 264).

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## 15.8 The laity

### 15.8.1 Attending church

**Sermon and catechism.** Every order requires attendance at the Sunday sermon, and most the afternoon catechism. The duty fell on the head of the household for children and servants. **Hohenlohe, *Polizei- und Rügordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 15, p. 594):

> Eß söll jederman an son- und feyertagen die predig besuchen, auch ihre kinder und ehehalten dartzue schicken und anhalten. Eß soll ein jeder, so seinen verstand erreicht, im jar zum wenigsten einmall oder zway das nachtmall empfahen.

Every man shall attend the sermon on Sundays and holy days, and send and hold his children and servants thereto. Every one that hath reached his understanding shall receive the Supper at the least once or twice in the year.

**Counted and fined.** In Nassau-Weilburg church censors went round during the service to note those in the streets, churchyard, taverns, workshops or barns. In the villages the people were counted house by house. **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576** (Sehling 10, p. 309):

> daß insonderheit in Flecken und Dorffschafften, bevorab Sontags und uff die höhere Fest-, Feyer- und Bettage, vor der Kirchen von Hauß zu Hausse umbgezehlet unnd diejenige, so ohne erhebliche Ursach und vorher gebettener Erlaubnus abwesendt befunden, ohnnachlässig mit einer gewissen Mulcta oder Kirchenbuß nach Inhalt dieser Censur Ordnung gestrafft werden.

that especially in market towns and villages, above all on Sundays and on the higher feasts, holy days and prayer days, a count be made from house to house before the church, and those found absent without weighty cause and without leave asked beforehand be punished without fail with a fixed fine or church penance, according to this order of censure.

No one was exempt: not the lords' servants, nor those in privileged houses, nor millers, bakers, innkeepers, journeymen and carters (Sehling 10, p. 309). Belzig in 1529 already bound "all householders" to send children and servants to the quarterly catechism sermons on pain of punishment by the district officer and the council (Sehling 1, p. 527). Where a war or plague service was called by the bell, Hohenlohe in 1588 required "at the least one person out of every house" to come, and those at home to pray with them (Sehling 15, p. 542).

### 15.8.2 Prayer and teaching at home

**The household as a church.** The orders assume that the head of the household teaches the catechism at home and leads prayer, as Luther's Small Catechism directs ("how a householder should teach his household"). Brandenburg-Nürnberg (1533) has the pastors exhort parents. **Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533** (Sehling 11, p. 188):

> Sie sollen auch die eltern und hausväter fleißig vermanen, das sie ire kinder und hausgesind zur predig und gemainen gebet ziehen und sunderlich darauf acht haben, das sie nicht one redliche ursach sich allzulang vom heiligen sacrament entziehen.

They shall also diligently exhort the parents and householders to draw their children and household to the sermon and to common prayer, and especially to take heed that they withdraw not themselves too long from the holy sacrament without honest cause.

Saxony in 1580 tells parents to teach their children and servants "at home in the chief parts of the catechism" before sending them to confession, "for some are found so unskilled that they know not even what the holy sacrament is" (Sehling 1, p. 427). The Reformed synod of Dillenburg in 1582 sent pastors and elders into the houses. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode*, 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 173):

> 1. Die pfarherren oder seniores und presbyteri halten visitationem domesticam, dabey sie mitt aller freundlicheit die leuthe ermahnen und erbauwen sollen, und sonderlich darane seyen, daß die jugendt daheim morgents und abents, auch vor und nach eßens und an der arbeit, zum gebeth und psalmen zu singen angehalten werden.

1. The pastors, or the seniors and presbyters, shall hold domestic visitation, wherein they shall exhort and edify the people with all friendliness, and especially see to it that the youth be held at home, morning and evening, also before and after meals and at their work, to prayer and to the singing of psalms.

The bells called the absent to prayer as well: when the Litany began, Hohenlohe in 1581 had the great bell rung "so that every man in the field or in the houses be reminded of the common prayer", to join it "in spirit" though absent in body (Sehling 15, p. 452; Chapter 9).

#### 15.8.3 Confession and communion

**How often.** The orders cite Luther's preface to the Small Catechism: whoever does not seek the sacrament "at the least once or four times a year" is to be feared a despiser of it (Palatinate 1556, Sehling 14, p. 135; Danzig 1557, Sehling 4, p. 230). The legal minimum was usually once or twice a year (Hohenlohe 1588, above). The Schulenburg order of 1572 had pastors admonish and then report to the lords those who did not go "at the least once or twice in the year" to confession and the sacrament, "and such a one shall not be suffered in the parish at all" (Sehling 3, p. 149). Before communion every communicant went to confession or to the examination (*Verhör*) (Chapter 3).

Private confession and absolution are treated in Chapter 13, §13.17.

#### 15.8.4 Church workers: a higher standard

**Lay officers held to the minister's standard.** Sextons, organists, schoolmasters and church wardens were not ordained, but the orders held them to the conduct required of ministers. Hesse in 1566 (Moderate Reformed) says so of the sextons ("*Opfermänner*"). **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

> Es sollen auch dieselbige gleich wie andere diener der kirchen eines erbaren und gottseligen wandels sein, kein volseufer, nit unehrlich hantierung treiben. Es sollen aber gemelte opfermenner durch die pfarherr und eltesten darzu mit wissen und willen eines superintendenten angenommen werden.

These also, like other ministers of the church, shall be of honest and godly conduct, no drunkards, nor ply dishonest trades. And the said sextons shall be taken on thereto by the pastors and elders with the knowledge and will of a superintendent.

Oldenburg in 1573 complained that "godless knaves who go about with the black art, soothsaying, charming, conjuring devils, treasure-digging, also with blasphemy, drunkenness and other offensive wicked pieces" had been taken on as sextons (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1121). Hoya (1581) forbade "our pastors, schoolmasters and sextons" to be found "in offensive company in common drinking-bouts and public taverns" (Sehling 6/2, p. 1141). Visitors asked about the sexton's communion as about the pastor's. In the Oldenburg visitation protocols of 1609, quoted in Sehling's notes, one sexton was found "not yet [to have gone] *ad coenam*", and another had kept from the sacrament nine years over a quarrel (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 1185, 1189).

**The minister's household.** The higher standard reached the minister's wife, children and servants (§15.3.3). The elders of the Reformed churches were to be "blameless" by the rule of 1 Timothy 3; their duties are in Chapter 16, §16.6. No order found lays a special prayer rule on the minor offices; their duty was attendance, good conduct, and the service of the choir or the church door.

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## 15.9 Schoolmasters

#### 15.9.1 A church office

**Teacher, singer and catechist.** The schoolmaster was counted among the "ministers of churches and schools" and was bound to the same life (§15.3.3). His church duties were:

- to teach the catechism and prayers;
- to lead the boys in church and lead the singing;
- to bring them to the sermon and watch them there;
- to obey the pastor and the visitors.

His installation and oath are in Chapter 13, §13.12.3, and the choir service in Chapter 10, §10.6.1. Esslingen's ten articles for the German schoolmaster (1534, Moderate Reformed) are the shortest complete statement. **Esslingen, *Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister*, [1534]** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 381):

> 1. Er sol sich beflyssen, die kinder zu underwysen und uffzuziehen in gottesforcht, zucht und erberkeit lut des heilgen evangelionß und der teglichen predigen. […] 3. Der schulmeister sol sich mit leer und gantzem leben allergstalt halten, domit die kinder kein böß exempel von im nemmen, wie sich gezympt eynem christlichen, getruwen lermeister. 4. Die fragstuck, klein und groß kinderbericht, sullen in der schul in steter übung gehalten werden und den kindern furgegeben zu buchstaben und lesen an stat der nammen buchlin, ehe denn sy andere brieff oder bucher angryffen. 5. Er sol die kinder mit flyß zu predigen füren, namlich am suntag und uff mitwoch zum kinderbericht. […] 7. Er sol die kinder wol uben in zehen gebotten, glauben, vatter unser, sacramenten, in psalmen singen und derglychen, wie die buchlin der fragstuck ußwysen. 8. Das groß fragstuck sol mann lesen, das klayn sol man ußwendig lernen.

1. He shall endeavour to instruct the children and bring them up in the fear of God, discipline and honesty, according to the holy gospel and the daily sermons. […] 3. The schoolmaster shall so behave himself in teaching and in his whole life that the children take no evil example from him, as becometh a Christian, faithful teacher. 4. The questions, the small and great children's instruction, shall be kept in constant use in the school and given to the children for spelling and reading instead of the name-book, before they take up other letters or books. 5. He shall diligently lead the children to the sermons, namely on Sunday, and on Wednesday to the children's instruction. […] 7. He shall exercise the children well in the Ten Commandments, the Creed, the Our Father, the sacraments, in singing psalms and the like, as the booklets of questions direct. 8. The great questions they shall read; the small they shall learn by heart.

The catechism thus served as the reading primer.

### 15.9.2 In church with the boys

**Leading them to the sermon.** In the towns the German schoolmasters brought their pupils to the weekday sermon and sang before and after it, so that the Latin school need not lose its hours. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 370):

> ist für rathsam angesehen, da in einer stadt deutsche schulen seind, das dieselben schulmeister mit ihren knaben zu rechter zeit, wenn zu der predigt geleutet wird, in die kirchen kommen, und mit ihnen einen deutschen gesang oder zweene singen, darauf die predigt folgen sol. Und wenn dieselbige volendet, sol abermals ein deutscher gesang von ihnen sampt dem volk gesungen werden.

it is deemed advisable, where there are German schools in a town, that the same schoolmasters come with their boys into the church at the right time, when the bell is rung for the sermon, and sing with them a German hymn or two, whereupon the sermon shall follow; and when it is ended, a German hymn shall again be sung by them together with the people.

At Wittenberg (1533) a school servant sat with the boys who could not get into the pew, "to see that they hear the sermon and play no knavery" (Sehling 1, p. 703). In Norderdithmarschen (1597) the boys gathered at their teacher's house before the service on Sundays and feasts and went with him "in orderly, modest array into the church, to hear the sermon and help with the singing" (Sehling 23, p. 502). The Oschatz visitors of 1555 wanted the boys "held to diligent attention and to noting down the sayings from God's word, and always diligently asked what they have learned from the sermon" (Sehling 1, p. 631).

### 15.9.3 Girls' schools and schoolmistresses

**Schoolmistresses.** Girls had their own schools in the larger towns, with schoolmistresses or a schoolmaster for the girls:

- Brück (1530) has the schoolmaster teach "the young maidens … under eleven years with reading and writing, also in the catechism and good sayings of Scripture" (Sehling 1, p. 535);
- Wittenberg's maidens came on weekday mornings while the sermon bell rang (1533, Sehling 1, p. 706);
- in the Reformed Palatinate in 1595 "every schoolmaster" was to lead his boys, and "every schoolwoman her schoolgirls", to the catechism sermon and present them to the ministers (Sehling 19/2, p. 856).

#### 15.9.4 Oversight

**Visited by the pastor.** The pastor visited the school. Saxony in 1555 required the pastors, "at the least four times every year", with a burgomaster or councillor, to "view the schools, examine the children", and see that the school servants "live without offence … and abstain from frivolous clothing, also from ale-houses, gluttony and such vices" (Sehling 1, p. 313). The Württemberg special superintendent asked "whether the schoolmaster with his colleagues keep the school in order and at its time … and furnish the church with Christian hymns, and what conduct he and his colleagues lead" (1559, Sehling 16, p. 388).

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## 15.10 The magistrate

#### 15.10.1 Keeper of both tables

**Lutheran doctrine.** The Lutheran orders follow Melanchthon in making the Christian magistrate "keeper of both tables" of the Law: responsible not only for the second table (civil order) but for the first (true worship), so far as outward discipline goes. Mecklenburg in 1552 states it plainly. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 189):

> Sondern die weltliche oberkeit ist gott diesen dienst schuldig im ganzen göttlichen, ewigen gesetz, das ist erstlich alle eusserliche, erkante abgötterei, zeuberei, eidbruch, gotteslesterung, öffentliche ketzerei sollen sie abthun und strafen, und dagegen rechte lere von gott pflanzen lassen und helfen erhalten […] Und in summa, die oberkeit sol beide tafeln der zehen gebot, gott zu ehren, in erhaltung eusserlicher zucht handhaben mit ernstlicher execution.

But the worldly authority oweth God this service in the whole divine, eternal law: that is, first, they shall put away and punish all outward, known idolatry, sorcery, perjury, blasphemy, open heresy, and on the other hand let true doctrine of God be planted and help to maintain it […] And in sum, the authority shall uphold both tables of the Ten Commandments, to the honour of God, in maintaining outward discipline with earnest execution.

The Palatinate repeated the passage almost word for word in 1556 (Sehling 14, p. 219).

**Nourisher of churches and schools.** The Transylvanian Saxons add the image of the magistrate as foster-father of the church, from Isaiah 49:23. **Transylvania, *Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode*, 1572** (Sehling 24, p. 349):

> ad cuius conservationem opus est ecclesiis et scholis earumque doctoribus, quorum pii magistratus debent esse defensores et nutritores, Esaiae 49 cap. dicitur. Debet quoque magistratus Christianus tollere scandala manifesta ex ecclesia, ut idolatria et impia dogmata pugnantia cum verbo Dei horrendasque blasphemias in Deum

for whose preservation there is need of churches and schools and their teachers, of which pious magistrates ought to be defenders and nourishers, as it is said in the 49th chapter of Isaiah. The Christian magistrate ought also to remove manifest offences out of the church, such as idolatry and impious doctrines contrary to the word of God, and horrible blasphemies against God.

#### 15.10.2 What the magistrate did

**Duties in practice.** The magistrate's duties were these:

- **To order visitation.** The prince sent the visitors and gave the reason. **Lüneburg, *Instruktion zu den Visitationen*, 1565** (Sehling 6/1, p. 576):

> Weil uns der allmechtig in dis hohe ampt der oberkeit gesetzt, das wir uns schuldig erkennen, vor allen dingen Gotts ehr und unser bevolen underthanen selen und seligkeit zu furdern und fleiss zu haben, das sein wort lauter und reine geleret, sacramenta recht administriret, alle ergernuß abgeschaffet, gute disciplina und christliche zucht erhalten werde

Because the Almighty hath set us in this high office of authority, so that we acknowledge ourselves bound above all things to further God's honour and the souls and salvation of the subjects committed to us, and to take care that his word be taught clear and pure, the sacraments rightly administered, all offences removed, good discipline and Christian order maintained.

- **To appoint, pay and protect ministers.** Patrons and councils called ministers, but subject to the superintendent's examination (§§15.4, 15.7). The Saxon articles forbade patrons to charge "fief money" or to dismiss a pastor without cause shown before the consistory (1557, Sehling 1, p. 321). Councils paid ministers and schoolmasters from the common chest.
- **To enforce attendance and the Sabbath.** The district officer and council punished those who kept children and servants from the catechism (Belzig 1529, Sehling 1, p. 527). Absentees were fined (Nassau-Weilburg 1576, §15.8.1), and at Dillenburg in 1618 (Reformed) the fines went into the alms chest (Sehling 10, p. 203).
- **To punish what the church could only admonish.** The consistory handled "the degrees of admonition, and not the worldly punishment" (Saxony 1580, §15.5.3). What the church could not mend went to the magistrate: the Schulenburg lords were to punish or expel those who would not come to the sacrament (1572, Sehling 3, p. 149).
- **To refuse citizenship and marriage to the ignorant.** The Reformed Elector Palatine in 1599 and 1608 forbade his officials to admit anyone as a citizen, or let anyone marry, who did not know the catechism (§15.11.4).
- **To be preached to.** At Schwäbisch Hall a sermon "on the office of the magistrate" was preached each year before the council election (1615, Sehling 17/1, p. 165). The visitor began each rural visitation with an exhortation "on the office of Christian magistrates … namely, among other things, to take the church diligently in hand after the example of the pious King of Judah, Jehoshaphat" (Sehling 17/1, p. 186).

#### 15.10.3 The Reformed limit

**Bodies, not souls.** The Reformed orders drew the line more sharply. **Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, [1609]** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 512):

> Dan erstlich erstreckt sich das ampt der obrigkeit allein uber den leib und zeitliche guter der underthanen, uber die seelen aber der menschen und ihre ewige wolfahrt haben sie gar nicht zue herschen. Hingegen das ampt der eltesten gehet auf die gewißen der menschen, welche sie durch ihre vermahnung aus den sunden aufmuntern, durch den hamer des gottlichen gesetzes zerknirschen und zue Gott führen und durch die gnadenverheisung des evangelii widerumb aufrichten und trösten.

For first, the office of the magistrate extendeth only over the body and temporal goods of the subjects, but over the souls of men and their eternal welfare they have no rule at all. On the other hand, the office of the elders goeth to the consciences of men, which they rouse out of sin by their admonition, crush with the hammer of the divine law and lead to God, and raise up and comfort again by the promise of grace of the gospel.

Even so, a Hanau sermon plan of 1609 (Reformed) still called the magistrate *custos utriusque tabulae quoad disciplinam externam*, keeper of both tables as far as outward discipline goes (Sehling 10, p. 469). The ceremonies by which magistrates were installed and prayed for are in Chapter 13, §13.13.

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### 15.11 Catechesis: where the estates meet

Catechesis was the one duty shared by every estate:

- the pastor and deacon preached and examined;
- the schoolmaster drilled;
- the householder repeated it at home;
- the magistrate compelled attendance;
- the superintendent tested the results at visitation and synod.

The confirmation rites themselves are in Chapter 13, §13.6, and the catechism sermon in Chapter 11, §11.4.3. The catechism service itself, its hour, length and order, is in Chapter 10, §10.10.

#### 15.11.1 How often and how long

**Three rhythms.** The orders combine three rhythms of catechism teaching:

- **Weekly.** A catechism sermon or children's instruction on Sunday afternoon, often with a weekday repetition: Wednesday and Friday at Reuss (1528), "always half an hour" (Sehling 2, p. 151). The sermon was to last no more than half an hour (Nassau-Weilburg 1576, Sehling 10, p. 235). In a filial village the Sunday sermon was split, "half an hour" for the gospel and the other half for the catechism, said "word for word without exposition" (Eisfeld 1554, Sehling 1, p. 562).
- **Quarterly series.** The Saxon visitors of 1529 ordered the catechism preached four times a year, a fortnight each time, with penalties for householders who did not send their children and servants. **Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529** (Sehling 1, p. 527):

> Desgleichen das der katechismus zu vier maln im jar alweg 14 tag ufs wenigst nacheinander gepredigt werden, dohin wir alle beerbeten ire kind und gesind bei vormeidung des ambts und rats straf zuschicken vorbinden thuen

Likewise that the catechism be preached four times in the year, each time at the least fourteen days one after another, whither we bind all householders to send their children and servants on pain of punishment by the district office and the council.

At Brück (1530) the pastor preached "the long catechism every day" for a fortnight before each of the high feasts (Sehling 1, p. 535).

- **A yearly examination in Lent.** Saxony (1580) prescribed a "yearly examination of the catechism, which shall be held in Lent with the young servants" (Sehling 1, p. 424). Gotha (1555) taught the catechism daily in Lent from Invocavit to Palm Sunday (Sehling 1, p. 569). Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) held the yearly examination "most fitly in Lent, before the ordinary visitation", and told the pastors to use "all gentleness" and be content with "a fair answer" (Sehling 13, p. 177).

**House to house.** In small places the Saxon pastor examined his people one household at a time. **Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555** (Sehling 1, p. 313):

> Auch in den flecken, do der inwoner nit all zuvil, soll der pfarrer ein zeit im jar da zu nehmen, und ein haus nach dem andern fur sich bescheiden, und die, so nit lesen konnen oder den pfarrern unbekant und vordechtig sein, sonderlich aber kinder und dienstboten in sunderheit im catechismo examinieren. So kan er nachmals dieselben, die in solcher verhor geschickt befunden sind, mit besserem gewissen zu dem abentmal des herrn kummen lassen [...] Denn solchs durchaus soll gehalten werden, das niemand zu dem hochwirdigen sacrament zugelassen werde, der nit beten konne, und von den furnemsten artikeln der christlichen lehr, nit zimlichen bescheid an zeigen kann.

Also in the market towns where the inhabitants are not too many, the pastor shall take a time in the year for it and summon one house after another before him, and examine in the catechism those that cannot read or are unknown or suspect to the pastors, but especially children and servants, each by himself. So can he afterwards let those that are found fit in such examination come to the Lord's Supper with the better conscience [...] For this shall be kept throughout, that none be admitted to the holy sacrament who cannot pray and cannot give a fair account of the chief articles of Christian doctrine.

**What had to be known.** The minimum was the text of the chief parts: five in some orders (Ten Commandments, Creed, Our Father, Baptism, the Supper), six where the Office of the Keys was added. The Small Catechism was learned by heart, the Large one read or preached (§15.9.1).

### 15.11.2 Before first communion

**An examination, and often a set course.** Every order requires an examination before a child's first communion. Saxony (1580) puts it briefly. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 424):

> Zum fünften, sollen die pfarrer sonderlich die das erste mal zu dem hochwirdigen sacrament des leibs und bluts Christi gehen, im catechismo mit fleis examinieren, ob sie denselben gelernet haben, auch ob sie zu der communion sonsten zuzulassen, eigentlich erkundigen.

Fifthly, the pastors shall especially examine with diligence in the catechism those that go for the first time to the holy sacrament of the body and blood of Christ, whether they have learned it, and also inquire carefully whether they are otherwise to be admitted to the communion.

Hohenlohe (1578) gives the clearest answer to "how long". The children of about twelve were taught for an hour a day through Lent. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 277):

> Weiter sollen auch alle und jede pfarrer in stetten und dörfern alle jar, von Invocavit an biß auf Palmarum, diejenigen kinder, die umb das 12. jar sind und nun alters halben das heihg abendmal zum ersten mal empfahen sollen, im heiligen catechismo und den artikeln christlicher lehr alle tag ein stund, von 12 biß auf 1 uhr, unterrichten und dahin sehen, das keins zum abendmal gelassen werde, das mcht zuvor die sechs stück des catechismi könne und ein notwendigen verstand der christlichen lehr habe.

Further also all and every pastor in towns and villages shall every year, from Invocavit until Palm Sunday, instruct those children that are about twelve years old and by reason of age are now to receive the holy Supper for the first time, in the holy catechism and the articles of Christian doctrine, every day for an hour, from twelve until one o'clock; and see to it that none be admitted to the Supper who cannot first [say] the six parts of the catechism and have a needful understanding of Christian doctrine.

That is some five or six weeks of daily instruction, on top of years of Sunday catechism and school.

**Age.** The orders that name an age put first communion at about twelve:

- the Ansbach theologians in 1556 speak of children "of twelve years and above" (Sehling 11, p. 335);
- the Limpurg visitors in 1611 asked whether the pastor "communicates children under twelve years" (Sehling 16, p. 629);
- at Regensburg (1572/1588) children of "eight, nine, ten years" came to confession, and if they lacked understanding the parents were to be told "not to hurry with them" (Sehling 13, p. 510; §15.11.6);
- the Reformed church at Emden admitted children "about fourteen years", after a public profession before the congregation eight days before the Supper (Micron's *Ordinancien*, German edition of 1565, Sehling 7/1, p. 606).

### 15.11.3 First communion and confirmation

**Usually one act.** Was first communion separate from confirmation? In most orders that have a confirmation it is the same occasion: the children are examined, confirmed, and admitted to their first communion together. The Hessian form of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) is headed "Questions and answers for the children who are to be confirmed and admitted to communion for the first time" (Sehling 8, p. 300). The heading recurs in the Hessian *Agende* of 1574 (Philippist), Nassau-Weilburg 1576 and Hanau 1609 (Reformed) (Sehling 8, p. 433; 10, pp. 254, 498). Mansfeld held the examination publicly in church the day before. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 233):

> Nach dem auch in unsern kirchen bis daher diese christliche gewonheit erhalten ist, das man die kinder, so zum ersten mal zum hochwirdigen sacrament gehen sollen, den nehesten tag zuvor, ehe denn es geschiehet, in der kirchen offentlich verhöret, und hierzu alle monat ein gewisser tag in jeder kirchen geordnet und benennet wird, das sie auch, wenn sie im catechismo verhöret und bestanden sind, alda nach altem und löblichen gebrauch der kirchen confirmiret, und uber sie gott der herr angerufen und gebetet wird, so ermanen wir alle christliche, gottfürchtige eltern und hausherren, auch schulmeister und schulmeisterin, das sie solche gewonheit erhalten helfen, und auf benente zeit ire kinder, gesind, Schulkinder, den seelsorgern zuverhören selbst fürstellen

Whereas also in our churches this Christian custom hath been kept hitherto, that the children who are to go for the first time to the holy sacrament are publicly examined in the church on the next day before it happeneth, and for this a fixed day is ordained and named every month in every church, and that when they have been examined in the catechism and have passed, they are there confirmed according to the old and laudable use of the church, and the Lord God is called upon and prayed to over them: so we exhort all Christian, God-fearing parents and householders, also schoolmasters and schoolmistresses, that they help to maintain this custom, and at the named time themselves present their children, servants and schoolchildren to the pastors to be examined.

**Twice a year at Lauenburg.** Saxe-Lauenburg (1585) confirmed twice a year, on the Sunday before Michaelmas and on Quasimodogeniti. The parents first examined the children at home and had their schoolmasters hear them, "that they may give good account … distinctly, with clear voice, without shyness", and then presented them before the altar with the godparents (Sehling 5, pp. 458–459).

**A second hearing.** Hessen-Kassel (1610, Reformed) required the newly confirmed to repeat their confession half a year later before the second communion. **Hessen-Kassel, *Konsistoriumsordnung*, 1610** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 118):

> so sollen die kinder, beits, knaben und megtlein, nicht allein, wann sie zum ersten mahl zum h. nachtmal gelaßen und confirmirt werden, zuvor ihr bekantnis nach allen fünff hautpstucken christlicher lehr dem pfarherrn thun, sondern sie

> sollen auch dieselbe jahr ihre bekantnis zu mehrer und fernerer behaltnis alzeit ein halb jar nach der confirmation fur dem pfarherrn wiederholen und darauff zum andern mahl communiciren

the children, both boys and girls, shall not only, when they are admitted for the first time to the holy Supper and confirmed, first make their confession before the pastor according to all five chief parts of Christian doctrine, but they shall also in the same year, for the better and longer keeping of it, always repeat their confession before the pastor half a year after the confirmation, and thereupon communicate the second time.

**Examination without confirmation.** Where there was no confirmation rite, as in Electoral Saxony, the examination alone admitted the child to communion (above; Chapter 13, §13.6.7). No order requires a separate course for confirmation apart from the course for first communion. The one instruction served both.

#### 15.11.4 Before marriage

**No catechism, no banns.** Many orders refused to proclaim or marry the young who did not know the catechism. **Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 436):

> und da es junge leute, ob sie auch iren catechismum gelernet, ohne dessen erkentnis sie nicht aufgeboten werden sollen.

and if they be young folk, [the pastor shall inquire] whether they have also learned their catechism, without knowledge of which they shall not be proclaimed.

The pastor was also to ask "whether they have received the holy sacrament publicly in the church with the congregation of God" (Sehling 1, p. 436). Pfalz-Neuburg (1576) set out the whole interview: kinship, parents' consent, freedom from other promises, and the catechism. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 195):

> erstlich, ob und wie si einander mit sipp- oder magschaft verwandt, zum andern, ob es mit wissen und willen der eltern und nit heimblicher weise beschehen, zum dritten, ob si beede ledig und sonst niemands anderm versprochen seien, solchem nach si beede aus dem catechismo, wie si desselben einen underricht haben, verhören. Da nun in solchem allen kain mangl befunden, sollen die neue eheleut ohne alle hindernus vermög der kirchenordnung eingesegnet werden.

first, whether and how they be related to one another by blood or by marriage; secondly, whether it hath been done with the knowledge and will of the parents and not secretly; thirdly, whether they be both single and not promised to any other; and after this, examine them both out of the catechism, how far they have instruction in it. If now no defect be found in all this, the new married folk shall be blessed without any hindrance according to the church order.

**Why the household needed it.** Zweibrücken (1574) gives the reason: the couple would have to teach their own children and servants. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574** (Sehling 18, p. 529):

> Es sollen auch die Pfarrer die newen eheleuth zu sich vor dem kürchgang fordern und von ihnen Rechenschafft ires glaubens und der lehr des Catechismi begehren. Dann weil sie haußhalten sollen, khinder und gesünde bekhommen, ist jhe nutz, ja es erforderts die hohe nott unnd der ernnste bevelch Gottes, das sie sich und die selbigen wissen in bekantnus Christlicher lehr und wahrer Religion Recht zu underrichten und auffzuziehen

The pastors shall also call the new married folk to them before the church-going and require of them an account of their faith and of the doctrine of the catechism. For since they are to keep house and get children and servants, it is profitable indeed, yea, the high necessity and the earnest command of God require it, that they know how to instruct and bring up themselves and them rightly in the confession of Christian doctrine and true religion.

Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) has the same rule (Sehling 8, p. 322). The rule was repeated across the later century:

- Mansfeld, by resolution of its ministers, 1580 (Sehling 2, p. 233);
- the Transylvanian synod of Hermannstadt, 1565: if they cannot answer, "one shall delay the copulation until they learn" (Sehling 24, p. 296);
- Prussia, 1568 (Sehling 4, p. 93);
- the Hessian *Reformationsordnung* of 1572 (Philippist): the ignorant were not to be married, nor admitted to communion or to stand godparent, and were to be reported to the authorities (Sehling 8, p. 398);

- Nassau-Diez 1585 (Reformed), Ysenburg-Birstein 1588, Marienhafe 1593 and the Solms discipline order of 1599 (Reformed) (Sehling 10, p. 177; 10, p. 632; 7/1, p. 717; 9, p. 339).

The Reformed Elector Palatine in 1599 and 1608 forbade his officials to accept anyone as a citizen, or let anyone marry, without a pastor's written certificate that they could recite the chief parts (Sehling 19/2, pp. 963–964).

**Married on a promise.** Where a wedding could not be put off, Wied (1616, Reformed) married the couple on a pledge, backed if need be by sureties. **Wied, *Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung*, 1616** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 500):

> Und da auß erheblichen ursachen etwa die copulation angehender, junger eheleut länger nicht uffgeschoben werden könte, so sollen die angehende eheleut handtgegebener trew zusagen, auch, da nötigh, deßwegen burgen setzen, das sie bei der catechismi predigten sich fleißigh einstellen und finden laßen wollen, biß sie die lehr desselben wolgelernet und gefaßet haben.

And if for weighty reasons the copulation of young folk about to marry could be put off no longer, then the couple shall promise by giving their hand, and also, if need be, set sureties for it, that they will diligently attend and be found at the catechism sermons until they have well learned and grasped its doctrine.

#### 15.11.5 Premarital instruction and counsel

**No counselling course.** No order prescribes premarital counselling in the modern sense: a series of meetings on the duties of marriage. What the orders require is three things.

**1. An interview some weeks before.** The couple, or their parents, came to the pastor in good time. At that meeting the pastor established their freedom to marry and examined their faith. **Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 16, p. 621):

> Erstlichs sollen die Newe Eheleuth oder an ihrer statt die Eltern, Vormundt oder Freundt beederseits drey wochen vor ihrem Kirchgang bey dem Pfarherr sich einstellen oder, do ein oder ander theil abwesent, von ihnen schrifftlichen beglaubten schein bringen, der dann fleissig auffsehen und forschen soll, ob es mit wissen und willen geschehe deren, in welcher gewaldt sie sein, sonderlich der Eltern, ob kein verhinderung wegen naher verwandtschafft oder anderer wichtigen ursachen

First, the new married folk, or in their stead the parents, guardians or kinsfolk on both sides, shall present themselves before the pastor three weeks before their church-going, or, if one or the other party be absent, bring a written attested certificate from them. And he shall diligently look and inquire whether it be done with the knowledge and will of those in whose power they are, especially the parents, [and] whether there be no hindrance by reason of near kinship or other weighty causes.

In the villages of Brieg (1592) "the bride and bridegroom shall first recite the parts of the catechism to their pastor on a set day" (Sehling 3, p. 447). The Brieg visitation instruction of 1542 had already ordered people to come when the pastor sent for them, "especially when people would enter into the estate of marriage" (Sehling 3, p. 441).

**2. Confession and communion before the wedding.** Schwäbisch Hall's revised order of 1615 joins the examination to confession. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543, revised text of 1615** (Sehling 17/1, p. 155):

> Sonderlich aber sollen Newe Eheleuth den H. Ehestandt in Gottesforcht anfahen, mittlen und volenden, den Segen von Gott zuerlangen, auch vor der Hochzeit sich zur Beicht schicken und darauff die Absolution und das H. Abendtmal empfahen zu erweckung und stärckung eines guoten Fürsatzs, Gott in disem Standt nach seinem Wort zudienen und also Christum zur Hochzeit laden, der kan im Ehestandt auß Wasser Wein machen, das ist, Leyd inn Frewd verwandlen. In der Beicht sollen billich die Jungen, Newen Eheleuth auff deß Pastoris examen von der Lehr deß H. Catechismi Rechenschafft geben

But especially shall new married folk begin, continue and end holy matrimony in the fear of God, to obtain the blessing from God, and also before the wedding betake themselves to confession and thereupon receive absolution and the holy Supper, for the awakening and strengthening of a good purpose to serve God in this estate according to his word, and so to invite Christ to the wedding, who can turn water into wine in matrimony, that is, sorrow into joy. In confession the young new married folk ought rightly to give account, upon the pastor's examination, of the doctrine of the holy catechism.

Freudenthal (1592) required bride and groom to come "together to confession and to God's table before the wedding" (Sehling 3, p. 480).

**3. The exhortation and the wedding sermon.** The teaching on marriage itself was given publicly, in the exhortation read at the wedding and in the wedding sermon (Chapter 11, §11.4.7). Pfalz-Neuburg allowed the exhortation, "which is in itself a fine short sermon on marriage", to be read "for the instruction and reminding of the new married folk" when there was no time for a sermon (1576, Sehling 13, p. 197). Schwäbisch Hall's pastors were pointed for marriage cases to the handbooks of Hemmingsen, Heshusius, Bidembach, Beust, Porta's *Pastorale Lutheri* and Sarcerius (1615, Sehling 17/1, p. 155).

### 15.11.6 Infant communion

**No order gives the Supper to infants.** Did any order give communion to baptized infants, or argue for it? None does. Every order that speaks of first communion requires instruction and examination first (§15.11.2). Four orders name the communion of infants outright, and all four set it aside. Their reasons are three:

- the Apostle's command to examine oneself and discern the Lord's body (1 Corinthians 11:28–29), which infants cannot do;
- the judgment of the early church;
- the children of Christians are saved by baptism and faith without the Supper, so to wait does them no harm.

The orders of Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and Hohenlohe (Lutheran) grant that infant communion was the custom in the time of Cyprian and Augustine. Hesse leaves the custom "in its worth" and does not condemn it. The Reformed preacher at Markirch (1561) calls it an error of the ancients.

**Hesse: the ancient custom left unjudged.** The Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) prefaces its rite of confirmation with the history. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 286–287):

> Vor zeiten ward den kindern gleich wie den alten, so bald sie getauft, auch das sacrament des leibs und bluts Christi zu essen und zu trinken gereicht, wie das bezeugt Cyprianus in der predig de lapsis und Augustinus, wie zuvor vermeldt. Solchs lassen wir in seinem wert beruhen. Wir aber, zum teil bewegt durch den spruch des apostels: Der mensch prüffe sich selbst und also esse er von diesem brot und trinke von diesem kelche, etc., zum teil folgende dem gemeinen urteil der ersten kirchen, verziehen, das heilig abendmal den kindern zu reichen uf ein ander zeit, und achten notwendiger sein, daß, welche in der kindheit, da sie noch nicht vor sich selbst dem teufel absagen noch den glauben Christi bekennen mögen, durch die hei. taufe gereiniget und dem Herrn Christo und seiner kirchen eingeleibt seind, so bald die zeit kompt ihres verstands, daß sie mögen in den heuptartickeln christlicher lehr und religion underwiesen werden und itzt etlichermaßen underrichtet sein, daß sie alsdenn ihren glauben vor der kirchen bekennen und bericht geben von den vornemsten heuptpunkten christlicher religion [...]

In times past the sacrament of the body and blood of Christ was given to the children to eat and to drink, even as to the old, as soon as they were baptized, as Cyprian testifieth in the sermon *de lapsis*, and Augustine, as was said before. That we leave in its worth. But we, moved partly by the saying of the apostle, Let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of this bread and drink of this cup, etc., and partly following the common judgment of the first church, defer the giving of the holy Supper to the children unto another time. And we hold it more needful that those who in their infancy, when they could not yet of themselves renounce the devil nor confess the faith of Christ, were cleansed by holy baptism and incorporated into the Lord Christ and his church, should, so soon as the time of their understanding cometh, that they may be instructed in the chief articles of Christian doctrine and religion and are now somewhat taught, then confess their faith before the church and give account of the foremost chief points of the Christian religion [...]

Earlier, the same order explains the ancient custom by the early church's joining of baptism and the Supper. The newly baptized "all went straightway to the holy Supper, and so also in the times of holy Augustine it was given to the children, which we yet leave in its worth" (Sehling 8, p. 273).

**Oldenburg: infants cannot examine themselves.** The Oldenburg order of 1573 argues for infant baptism and, in passing, against infant communion. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1047):

> Nun kan man durchs blosse wort alleine mit den kinderlein nicht handeln, denn man kan sie noch nicht lehren, derhalben mus es durch die sacrament geschehen, wie im Alten Testament durch die beschneidung. Vom abentmal aber des Herrn

> spricht Paulus: Der mensch prüfe sich selbs, item, er sol unterscheiden den leib des Herrn, 1.Cor. 11, welches die jungen kinderlein noch nicht tun können.

Now one cannot deal with the little children by the bare word alone, for one cannot yet teach them; therefore it must be done through the sacrament, as in the Old Testament through circumcision. But of the Supper of the Lord Paul saith, Let a man examine himself; and again, he shall discern the Lord's body, 1 Cor. 11; which the young little children cannot yet do.

**Hohenlohe: children saved without the Supper.** Hohenlohe in 1578 answered those who held the Supper needless to the baptized believer. **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 334):

> Darnach, so ist es war, die kinder der Christen werden durch den glauben und tauf selig, on den gebrauch des nachtmals, wie Christus sagt: Wer glaubt und getauft wird, der wird selig. Wiewol es zu der zeit Augustini der brauch ist gewesen, das man die jungen kinder mit dem kelch des Herrn getrenkt hat, jedoch so volget hierauß nicht, das die erwachsenen nicht bedörfen des heiligen nachtmals und sey inen genug die empfangenen tauf und glauben.

Moreover, it is true that the children of Christians are saved through faith and baptism, without the use of the Supper, as Christ saith, He that believeth and is baptized shall be saved. Although in the time of Augustine it was the custom that the young children were given to drink of the cup of the Lord, yet it followeth not hereof that the grown need not the holy Supper, and that the baptism and faith they have received are enough for them.

**Markirch: an error of the ancients.** Arnaud Banc, preacher of the Reformed French congregation in the Leber valley at Markirch, in the lordship of Rappoltstein, explained in 1561 why his church would not carry the Supper to the sick. Private communion, he wrote, rested on a false belief. **Rappoltstein, Arnaud Banc's report on the doctrine of the French congregation, 1561** (Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 142):

> Raichet uff die opinion unnd meinung deren, die vermeinen, das alle personen, so das nachtmal nit entpfanngen heten, verloren werden; in welchem die alten auch geirt haben, welche deßhalben den kleinen kindern das nachtmal geraicht haben.

This pertaineth to the opinion and belief of those who suppose that all persons who had not received the Supper are lost; wherein the ancients also erred, who for that cause gave the Supper to the little children.

**Instruction first.** Other orders reach the same practice without naming the ancient custom. Brenz at Schwäbisch Hall in 1527 drew the line from the catechumenate of the early church. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen*, 1527** (Sehling 17/1, p. 66):

> Fuit et is mos in ecclesia recens orta, ut nemo ad baptismum admissus fuerit nisi qui ante sit cathecuminus. Nunc cum baptisemur pueri, instituendi sumus in rebus fidei, priusquam ad communionem cene dominice admittamur.

This also was the custom in the church newly risen, that none was admitted to baptism but he that had first been a catechumen. Now, since we are baptized as children, we must be instructed in the things of faith before we be admitted to the communion of the Lord's Supper.

The Limpurg visitors' question of 1611, whether the pastor "communicates children under twelve years" (§15.11.2), presumes the same rule.

**No harm to the child who waits.** An order that deferred the Supper had to say what became of a child who died before first communion. Regensburg told the confessors to warn parents not to hurry children of eight, nine or ten years who lacked understanding. **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 510):

> weil zu diesem sacrament ein sonderer verstand und prob gehörig, und daß ihnen an ihrer seligkeit, da sie sonsten wol erzogen, nicht nachteilig, wie die dann, so sie Gott aus diesem leben, ehe dann si zur communion kommen, abfordern solte, sowol als andere erwachsenen auf ihrer, der eltern begern sollen mit der gewöhnlichen proceß und ceremonien, laut der regimentsordnung zur erden bestättigt werden.

because to this sacrament belongeth a special understanding and trial; and that it is no hurt to their salvation, if they be otherwise well brought up; as also such children, if God should call them out of this life before they come to the communion, shall at their parents' desire be laid in the earth with the accustomed procession and ceremonies, as well as other grown persons, according to the order of government.

Henneberg abolished a custom of burying such children apart. **Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 316):

> Weil auch an etlichen orten bisanhero der brauch gehalten, das man die kindlein, so das abendmal Christi noch nicht empfangen, nicht mit den schülern, wie die alten, zur erden bestattet, so sol doch hinfort hierinnen kein unterscheid gemacht, sondern die kinder weniger nicht, als die alten, mit vorgesetzten ceremonien zum begrebnus gebracht werden.

And whereas in some places the custom hath hitherto been kept that the little children which had not yet received the Supper of Christ were not laid in the earth with the scholars, as the old are, henceforth no difference shall be made herein, but the children shall be brought to burial with the ceremonies set down above, no less than the old.

**The sick child.** The one exception to the order of instruction, confirmation and communion was the child in danger of death. Nassau-Dillenburg (1575, Philippist) kept the unconfirmed from the sacrament, but not a dying child who understood the catechism and asked for it. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575** (Philippist; Sehling 10, p. 155):

> Welche kinder auff solche weis noch nit verhort und confirmirt seint, die soll man vom sacrament abhalten, biß sie durch die confirmation aufgenomen werden. Doch so jemant under den kindern kranck und die schwachheit sich etwa geferlich ansehen ließ, so dasselbige zimlichermassen verstendigh und mit dem catechismo gefaßet und das abentmahell begeren wurde, soll es ime keineswegs abgeschlagen werden, ohnerachtet, das es die confirmation noch nicht entpfangen. Es soll aber nicht destoweniger ein solch kindt sich zur confirmation nach gelangter gesundheit eintzustellen verpflichten.

Those children that have not yet in such wise been heard and confirmed shall be kept from the sacrament, until they be received by confirmation. Yet if any among the children be sick, and the weakness seem somewhat dangerous, and the child be fairly understanding and grounded in the catechism, and desire the Supper, it shall in no wise be denied it, notwithstanding that it hath not yet received confirmation. But such a child shall none the less bind itself to present itself for confirmation when it hath recovered its health.

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## 15.12 Table by order

**How to read the table.** The table lists the orders that give the fullest provisions on each question, in date order. Section numbers refer to this chapter.

| Order | Vol. | Provisions (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1527 | 17/1 | baptized as children, so instructed before communion (15.11.6) |
| Belzig and the Saxon visitations, 1529 | 1 | quarterly catechism series, a fortnight each, enforced by penalties (15.11.1) |
| Brück, 1530 | 1 | daily catechism sermons before the high feasts; girls under eleven taught catechism (15.9.3, 15.11.1) |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, 1533 | 11 | householders to bring children and servants to sermon and sacrament (15.8.2) |
| Esslingen, 1534 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | ten articles for the German schoolmaster; catechism as primer (15.9.1) |
| Augsburg, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12 | superattendent and bishop "one thing"; rotating oversight (15.4.1) |
| Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | stipendiaries examined twice a year before all theology professors (15.6) |
| Nassau-Dillenburg synod, 1552 | 10 | *loci* set from synod to synod; pastors to buy books (15.7.5) |
| Mecklenburg, 1552 | 5 | magistrate keeper of both tables (15.10.1) |
| Electoral Saxony, *Generalia*, 1555 | 1 | superintendents' visitation and synod; weeks of instruction at Wittenberg; practice sermons; house-to-house examination; deacons' duties (15.3.5, 15.4.2, 15.7.2, 15.7.3, 15.11.1) |

| Order | Vol. | Provisions (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel*, 1557 | 1 | pastors' reading list and conduct; superintendent's synod; ordination examination and public sermon (15.3.2, 15.3.3, 15.4.2, 15.7.3) |
| Württemberg, 1559 | 16, 17/1 | Tübingen *Stipendium*: practice sermons corrected; visitation of the minister's household (15.3.3, 15.7.1, 15.7.2) |
| Markirch (Rappoltstein), 1561 (Reformed) | 20/2 | infant communion an error of the ancients (15.11.6) |
| Weimar, 1561; Jena, 1569 | 1 | prince as supreme president; superintendent as president of the consistory (15.5.1, 15.5.2) |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564; report, 1571 (Reformed) | 14 | trial sermon; new men to serve first as deacons; monthly convents with sermon criticism (7.3–7.5) |
| Hesse, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | candidates kept at Marburg for lectures; sextons held to ministers' conduct; confirmation and first communion together; infant communion deferred; catechism before marriage (15.7.3, 15.8.4, 15.11.3, 15.11.4, 15.11.6) |
| Lasseln (Transylvania), 1572; Mediasch synod, 1572 | 24 | elected deans; magistrate nourisher of churches and schools (15.4.4, 15.10.1) |
| Regensburg, 1572/1588 | 13 | children of eight to ten not hurried to communion; buried like adults if they die first (15.11.2, 15.11.6) |
| Oldenburg, 1573 | 7/2.1 | infants cannot examine themselves (15.11.6) |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, 1574 | 18 | catechism before marriage, for the household's sake (15.11.4) |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist) | 10 | sick child communicated before confirmation (15.11.6) |
| Nassau-Weilburg, 1576 | 10 | absentees counted house by house and fined; registers of confirmations (15.3.4, 15.8.1) |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, 1576 | 13 | four-point examination before marriage; consistory book of candidates (15.7.4, 15.11.4) |
| Hohenlohe, 1578; 1588 | 15 | daily hour of instruction in Lent before first communion at about twelve; communion once or twice a year; children saved without the Supper (15.8.1, 15.11.2, 15.11.6) |
| Saxony, 1580 | 1 | parish registers; consistory composition and business; German schoolmasters at sermon; first communicants examined; no banns without the catechism (15.3.4, 15.5.2, 15.5.3, 15.9.2, 15.11.2, 15.11.4) |
| Mansfeld, 1580 | 2 | monthly public examination and confirmation before first communion; no marriage without the catechism (15.11.3, 15.11.4) |
| Hoya, 1581 | 6/2 | residence and leave; books bought by the parish; ministers and sextons out of taverns (15.3.2, 15.3.4, 15.8.4) |
| Henneberg, 1582 | 2 | uncommunicated children buried like adults (15.11.6) |
| Dillenburg synod, 1582 (Reformed) | 10 | domestic visitation; prayer at home morning, evening and at meals (15.8.2) |
| Lauenburg, 1585 | 5 | confirmation twice a year, with parents and godparents (15.11.3) |
| Regensburg, 1588 | 13 | lay president of the consistory (15.5.2) |
| Strasbourg, 1598 | 20/1 | pastor's office in one visitation article (15.3.1) |

| Order | Vol. | Provisions (§) |
|---|---|---|
| Grubenhagen, 1600 | 6/2 | superintendent's sworn instruction (15.4.3) |
| Palatinate mandates, 1599, 1607, 1608 (Reformed) | 19/2 | new deacons' sermon outlines censured; no citizenship or marriage without the catechism (15.7.4, 15.11.4) |
| Hanau, 1609, 1612; Ysenburg-Birstein, 1608 (all Reformed) | 10 | magistrate over bodies, not souls; weekly consistory sessions (15.5.2, 15.5.3, 15.10.3) |
| Limpurg, 1610 | 16 | couple to come three weeks before the wedding (15.11.5) |
| Hessen-Kassel, 1610 (Reformed) | 9 | confession repeated half a year after confirmation (15.11.3) |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1615 revision | 17/1 | confession and communion before the wedding; catechism examined in confession (15.11.5) |
| Wied, 1616 (Reformed) | 19/1 | marriage on a pledge, with sureties, to attend catechism (15.11.4) |

## 15.13 Concordance of the orders quoted

**The concordance.** Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below, with the volume and pages of Sehling, the `eko.db` document that holds the text, and the sections where it is quoted. Orders cited only in summary can be found through the table in §15.12 and the text.

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Augsburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 55 | 338 | 15.4.1 |
| Belzig, *Ordnung der Stadt Belzig*, 1529 | 1, p. 527 | 63 | 15.11.1 |
| Brandenburg-Nürnberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 11, p. 188 | 270 | 15.8.2 |
| Electoral Saxony, *Generalia, alle superintendentes belangende*, 1555 | 1, pp. 313, 314, 315 | 36 | 15.3.5, 15.7.2, 15.11.1 |
| Electoral Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 1557 | 1, pp. 320–321, 322 | 37 | 15.3.2, 15.3.3, 15.4.2, 15.7.3 |
| Esslingen, *Artikel für den deutschen Schulmeister*, [1534] (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2, p. 381 | 881 | 15.9.1 |
| Grubenhagen, *Officium superintendentis Grubenhagici*, 1600 | 6/2, p. 1109 | 2058 | 15.4.3 |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, [1609] (Reformed) | 10, p. 512 | 211 | 15.10.3 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 | 2, p. 316 | 1247 | 15.11.6 |
| Hesse, *Stipendiatenordnung*, 1546 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 159 | 2255 | 15.6 |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 201, 211, 286–287 | 2257 | 15.7.3, 15.8.4, 15.11.6 |
| Hessen-Kassel, *Konsistoriumsordnung*, 1610 (Reformed) | 9, p. 118 | 2287 | 15.11.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 | 15, pp. 277, 334 | 574 | 15.11.2, 15.11.6 |
| Hohenlohe, *Polizei- und Rügordnung*, 1588 | 15, p. 594 | 613 | 15.8.1 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1140 | 2065 | 15.3.4 |
| Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1610 | 16, p. 621 | 729 | 15.11.5 |
| Lüneburg, *Instruktion zu den Visitationen*, 1565 | 6/1, p. 576 | 2006 | 15.10.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | Quoted in § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda*, 1580 | 2, p. 233 | 1241 | 15.11.3 |
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, p. 189 | 1922 | 15.10.1 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Synodalabschied*, 1552 | 10, p. 93 | 172 | 15.7.5 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Agende*, 1575 (Philippist) | 10, p. 155 | 182 | 15.11.6 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Abschied der Dillenburger Generalsynode*, 1582 (Reformed) | 10, p. 173 | 186 | 15.8.2 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1576 | 10, p. 309 | 198 | 15.8.1 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, p. 1047 | 2148 | 15.11.6 |
| Palatinate, *Mandat zu den Konventen, der Predigtaufsicht und den Diakonen*, 1607 (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 957 | 1195 | 15.7.4 |
| Palatinate, *Kirchenratsordnung*, 1564 (Reformed) | 14, p. 413 | 504 | 15.7.4 |
| Palatinate, Wenzel Zuleger's report on the classical convents, [1571] (Reformed) | 14, p. 446 | 504 | 15.7.5 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, p. 195 | 404 | 15.11.4 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 529 | 1011 | 15.11.4 |
| Rappoltstein, Arnaud Banc's report on the doctrine of the French congregation, 1561 (Reformed) | 20/2, p. 142 | 1371 | 15.11.6 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588 | 13, p. 510 | 452 | 15.11.6 |
| Regensburg, *Ordnung des consistorii*, 1588 | 13, pp. 513–514 | 453 | 15.5.2 |
| Saxe-Weimar, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569 | 1, p. 234 | 24 | 15.5.1 |
| Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580 | 1, pp. 370, 397, 403, 424, 436 | 44 | 15.3.4, 15.5.3, 15.9.2, 15.11.2, 15.11.4 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Ordnung der Gottesdienste an Werk- und Feiertagen*, 1527 | 17/1, p. 66 | 756 | 15.11.6 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543, revised text of 1615 | 17/1, p. 155 | 762 | 15.11.5 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1598 | 20/1, p. 689 | 1344 | 15.3.1 |
| Transylvania, Statutes of the Chapter of Lasseln, 1572 | 24, p. 361 | 1692 | 15.4.4 |
| Transylvania, *Bekenntnisformel der Mediascher Synode*, 1572 | 24, p. 349 | 1691 | 15.10.1 |
| Wied, *Kirchen- und Polizeiordnung*, 1616 (Reformed) | 19/1, p. 500 | 1100 | 15.11.4 |
| Württemberg, *Ordnung des Tübinger Stipendiums*, 1559 | 17/1, p. 561 | 813 | 15.7.2 |

# Chapter 16. Minor Orders, Deacons and Elders

This chapter covers what became of the medieval grades and liturgical offices below the priesthood in the evangelical church orders printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It also covers the new offices that took their place. It asks nine questions:

- Were any of the **minor orders** (porter, lector, exorcist, acolyte) or the **subdiaconate** kept as formal orders?
- Do the orders mention or prescribe the **liturgical roles**: lector, thurifer, candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius*), cross-bearer, torch-bearer, boat-bearer and master of ceremonies? This is asked whether or not a formal order stood behind the role.
- Where was the **diaconate** kept? Was it kept as an order below the presbyterate, as a liturgical role at the altar, or as a lay office for the poor?
- Where it was kept, was it held to be a separate order **by divine right**, or only **by human right**? Were there **lay deacons**?
- Did any order have **lay elders** or **ruling elders**? Were they **ordained**?
- What did each of these offices do, and what were they forbidden to do?
- Which offices were **abolished** or **forbidden**?
- On what **grounds** were the offices kept, created or abolished?
- What became of the **sacristan**, of lay **care of the altar**, of **deaconesses**, and of **monks**, **nuns**, **tertiaries** and other members of religious communities? How were they received or installed?

The findings are summarised in §16.1, and §16.2 explains the method and the words that most often mislead. §16.3 deals with the minor orders and the subdiaconate, and §16.4 with the liturgical roles. §16.5 covers the diaconate in its three forms and the question of divine or human right. §16.6 covers elders. §16.7 covers sacristans, altar care, deaconesses, monks, nuns, tertiaries and confraternities. §16.8 gathers how each office was installed, and whether it was ordained. §16.9 is a table by order, and §16.10 a concordance of every order quoted.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the installation rites, with the full forms: Chapter 13, §§13.10–13.12;
- the duties of pastors and deacons, church workers and schoolmasters: Chapter 15, §§15.3, 15.8.4, 15.9;
- the oaths and promises of ministers and church officers: Chapter 17, §17.4;
- places at the altar in the ceremonial of the Mass: Chapter 2, §2.15.8;
- vestments and clerical dress: Chapter 14, §§14.7–14.8;
- the offices kept in the convents: Chapter 10, §§10.4.4, 10.6.3.

## 16.1 Summary of findings

**1. The minor orders were not kept as orders anywhere in the German church orders.** No order in the corpus ordains a porter, lector, exorcist or acolyte, nor a subdeacon in the medieval sense. Their disappearance is mostly silent. Where it is argued, the grounds are three:

- They have no warrant in Scripture. Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) says "Scripture knows no other ministers than bishops, that is presbyters, and deacons of the poor" (§16.3.2).
- They were later human additions to the apostolic diaconate. The Strasbourg examination order of about 1539 (Moderate Reformed) gives a short history of the grades (§16.3.1).
- They belong with the tonsure, the "platten", and other merely human ordinances. Freiberg 1537 and Brunswick 1528 say so (§16.3.3).

**The one exception lies outside the Lutheran and Reformed territorial churches.** The *Ordo ecclesiasticus* of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), printed among the Polish orders, keeps the **acolyte** as the first ordained grade, under the deacon (§16.3.4). The young men are received before the synod with a handshake, a promise and a blessing.

**2. The functions of the minor orders survived without the orders.**

- *Porter:* the porter's keys passed to the **sexton** (*Opfermann*, *Küster*). Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) calls him the *ianitor* of the Old Testament and the *aedituus* or *custos* of today (§16.3.5).

- *Lector:* reading passed to the **schoolboys**, who read the epistle at Vespers (Rostock 1560), and to the **deacon**, the assistant minister.
- *Exorcist:* the office disappeared altogether. Strasbourg (1539, Moderate Reformed) says exorcism was "rather a singular gift than a common function".

**3. The liturgical roles were rarely prescribed and soon dropped.**

- **Ministrants:** in the 1520s–1540s some Mass-shaped orders still have ministrants (*Ministranten*) at the altar. Examples are Nürnberg 1524 and Brandenburg 1540, the latter "in deacons' dalmatics" where there are enough clergy. In Pfalz-Neuburg 1543, "where there are ministrants", the subdeacon reads the epistle and the deacon the gospel and gives the cup (§16.4.1–16.4.2).
- **Levites:** Regensburg 1542 kept a full **levitical service**, with a priest celebrant and two "levites", a gospeller and an epistoler. Regensburg abolished the levites and their vestments in 1554, and again in its church order of 1567. Brandenburg-Ansbach's chapter order of 1565/78 forbade "levites after the papistical use" (§16.4.3).
- **Thurifer:** Luther left incense free in 1523, "we neither forbid it nor require it". Incense then disappears from the rubrics (§16.4.4).
- **Cross:** a **cross** is carried in a rogation procession at Stendal (1541) and before the coffin at funerals in many orders (Brandenburg 1540, Waldeck 1556, Anhalt, Prenzlau 1557). The bearer is a schoolboy or the sexton. Schwäbisch Hall (1615) allows it "significatively, not effectively" (§16.4.5).
- **Not found:** the corpus holds no candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius*), torch-bearer, boat-bearer or master of ceremonies as a prescribed role. Lights might still be carried at Brandenburg funerals and before the sacrament in Baden 1533, by bearers the orders do not name.

**4. The diaconate survived in three distinct forms, which the same word hides:**

- **The Lutheran *Diaconus*.** This is the second or third minister of a town church: a *Helfer*, *Kaplan* or *Capellan*. He is a full minister of the word and sacraments, **ordained with the same rite as a pastor**, and usually a step on the way to a pastorate. Electoral Saxony 1580 allows a gifted man to become a pastor "without passing through the diaconate" (§16.5.1). Württemberg and Saxony also have a *Subdiaconus*, a third minister. These are grades of benefice and seniority, not separate orders.
- **The liturgical deacon and subdeacon at the altar.** These occur in a few early orders and are normally priests acting as levites (§16.4.2).
- **The lay deacon of the poor.** This office was built on Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3:
  - In **Bugenhagen's** orders the treasury and alms deacons (*diakene*) are honest laymen who handle the common chest and visit no one with the word. Brunswick 1528 says they serve as Stephen and Lawrence did, "without tonsure and without deacon's coat" (§16.3.3, §16.5.2). The same office appears in Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531, Pomerania, and the Lutheran Dutch congregation at Frankfurt (1585).
  - Elsewhere they are called *leviten* (Hadeln 1526), *subdiaconi oder bittherren* (Naumburg 1537), or *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum*. In Pomerania 1574 the *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* are bound by oath; in Pyritz 1539, by express decision, by no oath.
  - In **Hesse 1566** (Moderate Reformed) and the **Reformed** churches (Micron 1554/65, Kurpfalz, Nassau, Bentheim) the deacons of the poor are one of the four offices. They are elected, examined, and in Hesse and Micron **ordained with laying on of hands** (§16.5.3).

**5. Divine or human right.** No church order sets the deacon as a separate order *by divine right* above the people and below the presbyter in the Roman sense. The positions are these:

- **One ministry of the word by divine right; grades by human right.**
  - Bugenhagen writes "bishops or preachers (which is all one thing)".
  - Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539 speaks of "the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors".
  - Melanchthon's *Wittenberg Reformation* (1545) puts bishops "as a grade above other priests" on grounds of "human foresight".
  - The Lutheran diaconate falls under this rule. It is one ministry, graded for order's sake (§16.5.4).
- **The lay deacon of the poor as an apostolic institution.**
  - Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed) says Scripture knows "deacons of the poor".

  - Strasbourg (1539, Moderate Reformed) says the diaconate was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles", the subdiaconate and the rest only "afterwards".
  - Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) cites Acts 6, and so do the Reformed orders. The editors of the Hildesheim volume read Bugenhagen's ranking of poor relief among "divine ordinances" as making the deacon's office one of divine right (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 811).
  - The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) keep the diaconate as a grade which "it is not fitting to cast out of the church", though "the Antichrist drew it into abuse".

**6. Lay elders existed, chiefly in the Bucerian and Reformed orders, and were often ordained.**

- **Strasbourg (about 1539)** (Moderate Reformed) teaches two "orders of presbyters": those who administer word and sacraments, and those "employed only for the discipline of the church". Its churchwardens (*Kirchenpfleger*) of 1553, in Marbach's Lutheran order, are these *seniores* and *presbyteri* (§16.6.1).
- **Hesse (1539, 1566)** (Moderate Reformed) has the elders elected by the ministers and congregation and confirmed with prayer. In 1566 they are **"ordained" with laying on of hands** under Acts 14:23. Elders also lay hands on new ministers at their ordination (§16.6.2).
- **The Reformed orders** have elected elders who govern with the ministers, exercise discipline (Matthew 18) and oversee the ministers' doctrine and life. The installation forms differ:
  - laying on of hands: Micron 1554/65 and Kurpfalz 1592 (both Reformed);
  - prayer and commendation only: Pfalz-Veldenz 1574;
  - handfast vow and public prayer: Kurpfalz about 1601 and Hanau 1609 (both Reformed);
  - a sworn oath: Solms 1594 (Reformed; §16.6.3).
- **The Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite) elect lay "political presbyters" (*presbyteri politici*), and female *presbyterae* for the women. These bind themselves by voice and handshake but receive no laying on of hands (§16.6.4).

**7. In the Lutheran orders "elder" is usually not an office of governance.**

- The *Kirchenväter*, *Kirchgeschworene*, *Kastenherren* and *Kirchenpfleger* are lay stewards of church goods and alms.
- Memmingen (1532, Moderate Reformed) gives its churchwardens "no temporal jurisdiction", "so that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city" (§16.6.5).
- *Seniores* in Ansbach, Pomerania and Silesia are senior **clergy** of a chapter or synod.

**8. What the offices could not do.**

- Lay deacons and lay elders did not preach or administer the sacraments.
- In the Bohemian order even the ordained deacon might distribute the bread and the cup, but only a minister "having the power of the keys" might pronounce absolution and recite the words of institution (§16.5.3).
- Reformed elders had spiritual discipline but no civil punishment. In the Reformed Kurpfalz the advocates of presbyteries pleaded their divine right against Erastus. By the editors' account the dispute was settled in 1569 by opinions of Beza, Ursinus and Zanchi, and in 1570 an edict set up church discipline (Sehling 14, p. 53; §16.6.3).

**9. Sacristans, altar care, deaconesses and the religious.**

- **Sacristans.** No order has a sacristan distinct from the sexton. The *Küster*, *Custos*, *Mesner* or *Sigrist* kept the chalices, vestments and font, prepared the altar, vested the pastor and went with him to the sick. Anhalt (1594, Philippist) and Sayn (1590) spell out the duties; Heilbronn (1543) forbids women to serve at the font (§16.7.1).
- **Altar guild.** None exists in the corpus. The altar was kept by the sexton and the lay churchwardens or deacons. Pomerania (1574) charges the *diaconi* with "the altar with its ornament". The confraternities and Kalands that had kept altars and lights were dissolved into the common chest from Leisnig (1523) onward (§16.7.2).
- **Deaconesses.** There is no order of deaconesses. The word *diaconissa* appears once, for the almoner of the convent of Keppel (1570). The nearest equivalents are the Bohemian *presbyterae* and the *Seelfrauen* and beguines appointed to nurse the sick under the pastor (Regensburg 1543, Nördlingen 1544, Heilbronn 1531) (§16.7.3).
- **Monks.** New professions ended everywhere. Monks might leave and marry with a settlement or stay with maintenance. A few abbeys (Herrenalb, Ravengiersburg) were kept as evangelical schools for the ministry under an evangelical abbot or prior, without vows (§16.7.4).

- **Nuns.** Many women's houses survived as evangelical convents. Admission was put under the prince or council; the vows were declared not binding; the consecrated habit was abolished or made optional, "for all Christians alike are clothed in baptism" (Mecklenburg 1572). Keppel (1570) prints a full evangelical rite of clothing with an oath, and elected *dominae*, abbesses and prioresses swore oaths of office (§16.7.5).
- **Tertiaries and confraternities.** Beguine and Lollard houses were closed to new members. Heilbronn turned its beguines into visitors of the sick. Herford counted the separate houses of the Brethren and Sisters of the Common Life among "factions and sects". No order kept or founded a third order (§16.7.6).

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## 16.2 Scope, sources and the words that mislead

**Sources.** The `eko.db` database was searched for the names of every grade and role in question, in German, Low German and Latin spellings. The searches covered:

- *ostiarius*, *Türhüter*, *ianitor*;
- *lector*, *Leser*;
- *exorcista*, *Beschwörer*;
- *acoluthus*, *Akolyth*;
- *subdiaconus*, *Unterdiakon*;
- *ministrant*, *Levit*, *Evangelier*, *Epistler*;
- *thuribulum*, *Rauchfass*, *Weihrauch*, *navicula*, *Schiffchen*;
- *ceroferarius*, *Kerzenträger*, *Fackel*, *Leuchter*;
- *crucifer*, *Kreuz vortragen*, *Kreuzträger*;
- *ceremoniarius*, *magister caerimoniarum*;
- *Diaconus*, *Diakon*, *diaken*, *Helfer*, *Kaplan*;
- *Eltesten*, *Senior*, *Presbyter*, *Kirchenpfleger*, *Kirchenälteste*, *Censor*;
- for §16.7: *Sakristei*, *Sigrist*, *Mesner*, *Küster*, *Custos*, *Glöckner*; *Oblaten*, *Altartuch*, *Bruderschaft*, *Kaland*; *diaconissa*, *Seelfrau*, *Seelnonne*, *Krankenwärterin*; *Kloster*, *Novize*, *Profess*, *Gelübde*, *einkleiden*, *Kappe*, *Weihel*, *Domina*, *Äbtissin*, *Priorin*; *Begine*, *Nollhart*, *Fraterhaus*, *Terziarin*.

The registers of the edition were used to find further passages. The passages were then read in context.

The corpus is very uneven on these matters:

- The **Lutheran** orders say almost nothing about the minor orders. They simply stopped ordaining them, and the Mass rubrics assume a pastor, a deacon (assistant minister), a sexton and a school choir.
- The **Bucerian, Hessian and Reformed** orders (Strasbourg and Hesse, Moderate Reformed; East Frisia, Kurpfalz, Nassau and the Wetterau counties, Reformed) say a great deal about elders and deacons. They argue for them from Scripture and the early Church.
- The **Bohemian Brethren's** *Ordo ecclesiasticus* (Hussite), printed in Sehling's Polish volume (vol. 4), is the only order in the corpus with a graded clergy below the presbyter.

**Words that mislead.** The same word often names quite different offices:

| Word | Usual meaning in the corpus | Also used for |
|---|---|---|
| *Diaconus*, *Diacon*, *Helfer*, *Kaplan* | In Lutheran towns, the second or third **ordained minister** of a parish (§16.5.1) | The **lay deacon of the poor** (Bugenhagen; Hesse, Moderate Reformed; the Reformed churches; §16.5.2–16.5.3); the **ministrant at the altar** in a few early Mass orders (§16.4.2) |
| *Subdiaconus*, *Unterdiacon* | In Saxony, Württemberg and Halle, the **third minister** of a town church (§16.3.3) | Naumburg 1537: a **lay alms-collector** (*bittherr*, §16.5.2); Pfalz-Neuburg 1543: the **epistoler** at Mass (§16.4.2) |

| Word | Usual meaning in the corpus | Also used for |
|---|---|---|
| *Levit*, *Leviten* | In Regensburg and Nürnberg, the **two assisting clergy** (gospeller and epistoler) at Mass (§16.4.3) | Hadeln 1526: the **lay deacons of the poor** (§16.5.2) |
| *Eltesten*, *Seniores*, *Presbyteri* | In Hesse (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders, **lay governing elders** (§16.6.2–16.6.3) | Also the **ministers of the word**, the "elders who labour in the word" (Hesse 1566, Moderate Reformed; Micron and Kurpfalz 1592, Reformed); in Ansbach, Pomerania and Silesia, the **senior clergy** of a chapter or synod (§16.6.5) |
| *Kirchenpfleger*, *Kirchenväter*, *Kastenherren* | In most Lutheran orders, **lay stewards** of church goods (§16.6.5) | Strasbourg 1553 (Lutheran): the **disciplinary elders**, "whom they named *seniores* and *presbyteri*" (§16.6.1) |
| *Ordinieren* | The ordination of a **minister of the word** | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Lippe 1538 and Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 also use it of **elders** and **deacons**. In Lippe it means simply to "appoint" deacons |

Two consequences follow:

- A list of the *Diaconi* of a Saxon or Württemberg town is a list of **clergy**. A list of the *diakene* of Brunswick or Hamburg is a list of **laymen**.
- "Elder" in a Lutheran church order usually means a churchwarden or a senior pastor, not a governing elder in the Reformed sense.

**Not covered.** The following are outside the scope of this chapter, except where they explain an office:

- Schoolmasters, cantors and organists. (Hamburg 1529 lists the sexton and the organists among the church servants, and the **midwives** "may well be called church servants" too.)
- Visitors and superintendents.
- Consistories.

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## 16.3 The minor orders and the subdiaconate

No evangelical church order in the corpus ordains porters, lectors, exorcists or acolytes, nor a subdeacon in the medieval sense of a major order. No order forbids them by name either: the minor orders are not abolished by statute but simply left out of the new ordination rites, which know only the one ministry of the word. Three passages give reasons for this. One order, that of the Bohemian Brethren, keeps the acolyte as a grade of its own.

### 16.3.1 Strasbourg: a short history of the grades

The Strasbourg examination order for candidates for the ministry (1539, Moderate Reformed) asks the candidate to account for the grades of the clergy. Its answers are the fullest statement in the corpus of how the reformers viewed them:

- There are two "orders of presbyters": those who preach and administer the sacraments, and the lay *seniores* "employed only for the discipline of the church" (on these see §16.6.1).
- The diaconate alone was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles".
- The subdeacons, archdeacons, lectors, acolytes and porters were added "afterwards" as helpers to the deacons.
- The exorcist's work was a charism, not an office.

**Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, after 9 September 1539, questions 93–95** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 310):

> 93. Quot sunt ordines presbyterorum? Responsio: Duo. Unus eorum, qui Evangelium et Sacramenta administrant, una cum disciplina, de quibus Paulus apostolus praecipit I Timoth. 3 [1-7] et Tit. 1 [7-9], Qui et Episcopi vocantur ab Apostolo. Alter eorum, qui tantum adhibentur ad disciplinam ecclesiae, quales seniores, ut olim Synagoga, ita

> postea ecclesia quoque habuit, sine quorum consilio nihil agebatur in ecclesia. […] 94. Quos alios sacros cleri ordines habet ecclesia? R.: Prima institutione Spiritus S[ancti] per Apostolos prodita habet ecclesia Diaconos. Postea substituti sunt his subdiaconi et praefecti archidiaconi, quorum munus fuit communes fidelium oblationes et Eleemosynas procurare et dispensare et in conservanda disciplina ecclesiae caeterisque ministeriis ecclesiae, presbyteris inservire ac ministrare, quare Diaconi, hoc est ministri, sunt vocati. Accesserunt etiam lectores, qui sacros libros in ecclesia recitabant, et Acoluthi, qui presbyteros sectabantur testimonii et ministerii gratia, et ostiarii, qui indignos sacris coetibus arcebant. Exorcistarum enim munus magis doni singularis erat quam communis functionis, quae sacro ministerio proprie et semper competat.
> 94. Quot sunt necessaria ministeria ecclesiae, quae et hodie habere oporteat? R.: Tria: Ministerium muneris pastoralis, procurationis pauperum et Scholae ad instituendam adolescentiam ecclesiae.

93. How many are the orders of presbyters? Answer: Two. The one, of them which administer the Gospel and the Sacraments, together with discipline, of whom Paul the apostle giveth charge, 1 Timothy 3 and Titus 1, who also are called Bishops by the Apostle. The other, of them which are employed only for the discipline of the church; such elders as of old the Synagogue had, so afterward the church also had, without whose counsel nothing was done in the church. […] 94. What other holy orders of the clergy hath the church? Answer: By the first institution of the Holy Ghost, delivered through the Apostles, the church hath Deacons. Afterward were set under these the subdeacons, and archdeacons set over them, whose office was to take charge of and dispense the common offerings and alms of the faithful, and in the keeping of the discipline of the church and in the other ministries of the church to serve and minister unto the presbyters; wherefore they were called Deacons, that is, ministers. There were added also lectors, which recited the holy books in the church; and Acolytes, which followed the presbyters for the sake of witness and of ministry; and porters, which kept the unworthy from the holy assemblies. For the office of the Exorcists was rather of a singular gift than of a common function, such as belongeth properly and always to the holy ministry. 95. How many are the ministries of the church which are necessary, which it behoveth to have even today? Answer: Three: the Ministry of the pastoral office, that of the care of the poor, and that of the School for the instructing of the youth of the church.

The same order gives the place once held by the deacons and subdeacons to the **schoolmasters**. They are to be "second from the order of priests". **Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/1, p. 304):

> ut sit ordo eorum, qui in scholis ministrant, secundus ab ordine Sacerdotum. Inter ministros ecclesiae et eo loco, quo olim Diaconi et subdiaconi erant, qui hanc quoque functionem, cum muneribus clerici non funguntur, procuratione eleemosynarum administrabant.

[…] that the order of them which minister in the schools be the second after the order of Priests: among the ministers of the church, and in that place where of old the Deacons and subdeacons were, which also administered this function, when they were not performing the duties of clerics, [together] with the care of alms.

#### 16.3.2 Homberg 1526: "Scripture knoweth no other ministers"

The Homberg church order (Moderate Reformed), which Francis Lambert drafted for the Hessian synod of 1526 and which was never put into force, is the only order that rejects the higher grades in so many words. It forbids the dalmatic and tunicle of the deacon and subdeacon because the orders they signify were "brought in without the testimony of God's words". **Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526, chapter [24]** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 46):

> Dalmaticas, hoc est papisticorum diaconorum vestes aut subdiaconorum nemo de caetero induat. Nolumus enim favere ordinibus illis sine Dei eloquiorum testimoniis introductis. Caeterum Scriptura alios nescit ministros, praeterquam episcopos, seu presbyteros et pauperum diaconos. De missariis autem diaconis nec iota quidem unum in utroque instrumento reperimus, tametsi episcoporum adiutores non incongrue diaconi, id est, ministri vocentur. Diaconus enim ministrum, et diaconia ministerium significat.

Let no man henceforth put on dalmatics, that is, the vestments of the papistical deacons, or of the subdeacons. For we will not favour those orders, which were brought in without the testimonies of the words of God. Moreover, Scripture knoweth no other ministers save bishops, or presbyters, and deacons of the poor. But of deacons of the mass we find not one jot in either testament; albeit the helpers of the bishops be not unfitly called deacons, that is, ministers. For deacon signifieth a minister, and diaconia a ministry.

The passage shows the whole later position in small:

- There is one ministry of the word, in which bishop and presbyter are one.
- There is one apostolic diaconate, for the poor.
- A "deacon" who is the pastor's assistant is allowed, but only in the loose sense of "minister" or helper.

#### 16.3.3 Human ordinances, tonsure and vestment

Elsewhere the minor orders go silently, together with the tonsure, the processional cross and the other "human ordinances" that the visitations swept away. **Freiberg, *Visitationsartikel* of Dr Jacob Schenk, 1537** (Sehling 1, p. 466):

> Alle menschliche satzungen, so bisher als nötig gehalten, sollen abgethan werden, unangesehen, ob sie wol got nicht verpoten hette, als leuten anders dan zu gotlichen emptern, mit dem creuz gehen, platten, kappen tragen, fasttage und andere gewisse zeit wehlen.

All human ordinances which have hitherto been held as necessary shall be done away, notwithstanding that God had not forbidden them: as ringing [of bells] otherwise than for divine offices, going with the cross, [wearing] tonsures, wearing cowls, fast days, and choosing other set times.

Bugenhagen makes the same point positively about deacons. The true deacon of Acts 6 needs neither tonsure nor deacon's vestment: Stephen and Lawrence were deacons without them. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 449):

> Sulke diakene, dewile se hebben de heymelicheit des loven in reyner conscientie, konen ock wol trösten mit Gades wörde de armen unde elenden, den se mit gelde to hulpe kamen, alse Sanctus Stephanus to Hierusalem dede unde Sanctus Laurentius to Rome ane platte unde ane diakenrock. By uns overs, wat deme worde Gades by den kranken tokumpt, dohn de predicanten mit der heymsökinge, also dat unse diakene alleyne van deme gemeynen gude gelt vorschaffen den notroftigen.

Such deacons, since they hold the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience, can also well comfort with God's word the poor and wretched whom they help with money, as Saint Stephen did at Jerusalem, and Saint Lawrence at Rome, without tonsure and without deacon's coat. But with us, whatsoever pertaineth to the word of God with the sick, that do the preachers with their visiting; so that our deacons only procure money from the common chest for the needy.

Hamburg repeats the point when it allows Lawrence to be remembered in the sermon. **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 514):

> He droch nene platte edder diakene rock, sunder was ein diaken, alse geschreven steit Actor. 6 und 1. Tim. 3.

He bare no tonsure nor deacon's coat, but was a deacon, as it is written, Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3.

**What survived of the name *Subdiaconus*.** In Württemberg, Electoral Saxony and some towns, *Subdiaconus* survived as the name of a **benefice**: the third preaching post of a town church, below the pastor, the preacher and the *Diaconus*. It was not a separate order. Württemberg's order for filling church posts treats "pastors, preachers, deacons, subdeacons" as one list of ministers of the word, each "called" and examined in the same way. **Württemberg, *Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen*, 1559** (Sehling 16, p. 348):

> Demnach soll keiner zu Pfarrer, Prediger, Diacon, Subdiacon, Catechisten oder anderm Kirchendienst vociert noch verordnet werden, er bringes dann zuvor seine Glaubwürdige, Rechtmessige Testimonia seiner geburt, herkommens, haltens

Accordingly shall none be called or ordained to [be] Pastor, Preacher, Deacon, Subdeacon, Catechist, or to other service of the church, unless he first bring his credible and lawful testimonies of his birth, descent, [and] conduct [...]

Electoral Saxony's great order of 1580 has a chapter "how all parishes, preacherships, diaconates and subdiaconates shall be filled". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580**, table of contents and chapter heading (Sehling 1, pp. 363, 375):

> Vom beruf und annemung der kirchendiener, und wie alle pfarren, predicaturen, diaconat und subdiaconat, bestellet werden sollen.

Of the calling and receiving of the ministers of the church, and how all parishes, preacherships, diaconate and subdiaconate shall be filled.

At Halle the *Unterdiaconi*, the junior ministers, were bound to visit those they had communed in sickness. They were thus ministers of the sacrament, not servers. **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 441):

> Die diaconi aber und sonderlich die unterdiaconi sollen diejenigen, so sie in leibesschwacheiten communicirt haben, unerfordert in ihrer krankheit zu besuchen verpflichtet sein.

But the deacons, and especially the subdeacons, shall be bound to visit, unasked, in their sickness those whom they have communicated in bodily infirmities.

#### 16.3.4 The one exception: the acolytes of the Bohemian Brethren

The *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum* (1576; Bohemian Brethren), printed in Sehling's Polish section, keeps a five-step clergy:

- **acolytes**, then **deacons**, then **ministers** (presbyters);
- above them, **con-seniors** and **seniors** (bishops).

The acolytes are boys and young men taken into the pastor's household to be trained for the ministry. The order justifies the grade from Samuel under Eli, Elisha under Elijah, the sons of the prophets, Christ's disciples and Paul's companions, and calls it apostolic. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum*, 1576** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, pp. 275–276):

> Acoluthi, sunt adolescentuli a pastoribus ecclesiarum in domesticam societatem, eo fine ut in futurum ecclesiae usum litteris et moribus diligentius quam apud parentes, vel alibi, instruantur, admissi. Sic etenim Samuel apud Eli, 1. Sam. III. 1. Elisaeus apud Eliam, 2. Reg. IV. 38. et turba filiorum prophetarum apud seniores suos, 2. Reg. IV. 20. exerceri soliti sunt. Sic et Christus discipulos antequam illis ministerium concredidisset, apud se fovit et exercitavit. […] Atque hinc est, quod iam inde ab apostolicis temporibus gradus iste in ecclesia usurpatus fuerit.

Acolytes are young lads admitted by the pastors of the churches into [their] household fellowship, to this end, that for the future use of the church they may be instructed in letters and manners more diligently than with their parents or elsewhere. For so Samuel was wont to be exercised with Eli, 1 Samuel 3:1; Elisha with Elijah, 2 Kings 4:38; and the company of the sons of the prophets with their elders, 2 Kings 4. So also Christ cherished and exercised the disciples with himself before he had entrusted the ministry to them. […] And hence it is that this grade hath been used in the church even from the apostolic times.

What the acolytes did, according to the same order (p. 276):

- live modestly and in willing service;
- learn the catechism, the Gospels, the shorter Epistles, the Psalms and the hymns by heart;
- read the sacred text at household prayers, and sometimes give a short exhortation on it.

They had no altar duties. The medieval acolyte's candles and cruets have become a seminary apprenticeship.

The order calls their admission an *ordinatio*, "the first grade of calling". It takes place before the synod, after an examination, and it has **no laying on of hands**; the Brethren kept that for deacons and ministers (§16.5.3, §16.8). **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Acoluthorum ordinatio"** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 279):

> Est autem ordinatio I. Acoluthorum. II. Diaconorum. III. Ministrorum. IV. Conseniorum. V. Seniorum. […] 2. Provocantur nominatim ex ordine, et se in ecclesiae conspectum sistunt. 3. Interrogantur coram tota synodo, num se ecclesiae usibus consecrare velint? num obsequia promittant? 4. Praeleguntur ipsis officia; de quibus supra. 5. Horum observationem illi manu stipulata promittunt. 6. Priores acoluthi dextrae porrectione in societatem eos cooptant. 7. Omnia votis, benedictione, et cantu sacro, concluduntur.

Now the ordination is: I. Of Acolytes. II. Of Deacons. III. Of Ministers. IV. Of Con-seniors. V. Of Seniors. […] 2. They are called forth by name in order, and present themselves in the sight of the church. 3. They are asked before the whole synod whether they will consecrate themselves to the uses of the church, [and] whether they promise obedience. 4. Their duties are read to them, of which above. 5. The keeping of these they promise with hand given. 6. The former acolytes take them into [their] fellowship by reaching forth the right hand. 7. All is concluded with prayers, a blessing, and a sacred song.

#### 16.3.5 Where the functions went

**Porter.** The porter's keys passed to the **sexton** (*Opfermann*, *Küster*, *Kirchner*, *Mesner*). This was a lay church servant, engaged and paid by the parish. Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) draws the line from the Old Testament gatekeepers to the *aeditui* and *custodes* of its own day. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 211):

> Ahn die superintendenten, pfarherr, eltesten und diacon haben auch unser kirchen etlich andere diener, welche, dieweil sie die schlüssel zur kirchen, darin die christliche gemein zusammenkompt, haben und verwaren, auf- und zuschließen, beinahe denjenigen gleich sein, welche man im alten testament janitores genennet und heut, wiegebreuchlich, aeditui und custodes heißen. Es sollen auch dieselbige gleich wie andere diener der kirchen eines erbaren und gottseligen wandels sein, kein volseufer, nit unehrlich hantierung treiben. Es sollen aber gemelte opfermenner durch die pfarherr und eltesten darzu mit wissen und willen eines superintendenten angenommen werden.

Besides the superintendents, pastors, elders and deacons, our churches have also certain other ministers, which, forasmuch as they have and keep the keys of the church wherein the christian congregation cometh together, [and] open and shut [it], are well nigh like unto them which in the old testament were called janitores, and today, as is customary, are called aeditui and custodes. These also, like other ministers of the church, shall be of an honest and godly conversation, no drunkards, [and] shall ply no dishonest trade. But the said sextons shall be received by the pastors and elders, with the knowledge and will of a superintendent.

Hamburg puts the sexton under the pastor "with locking, with ringing at the right time". He is hired and dismissed by the lay deacons who keep the church building (Sehling 5, p. 512). Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed) has the *aeditui* elected by the presbytery with the elders and deacons (§16.5.3).

**Lector.** Public reading passed to three groups:

- **Schoolboys.** At Rostock a boy reads the epistle at Vespers in Latin and another reads it in German "to the people". **Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576** (Sehling 5, p. 289):

> Darnach soll die epistel von einen iungen gelesen werden lateinisch, und nach der epistel das responsorium gesungen werden, drauf sol die epistel deutesch von einem knaben dem volke furgelesen werden

Thereafter shall the epistle be read in Latin by a youth, and after the epistle the responsory be sung; whereupon shall the epistle be read in German by a boy unto the people […]

- **The junior minister.** At Hof the *subdiaconus*, "a minister of the church", reads a collect drawn from the Sunday epistle, then the epistle, then its summary. **Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592** (Sehling 11, p. 425):

> Minister ecclesiae, puta subdiaconus, precatiunculam ex epistola dominicali seu festivali concinatam legit, post ipsam epistolam et tandem huius summam.

A minister of the church, to wit the subdeacon, readeth a little prayer composed out of the Sunday or festival epistle; after that the epistle itself; and lastly the sum thereof.

- **The assisting minister (*levite*)** in Nürnberg, who reads a whole chapter "in place of the lesson" and expounds it (§16.4.3).

**Exorcist.** No exorcist appears anywhere. Strasbourg's view (1539, Moderate Reformed) that exorcism was a charism, not an office (§16.3.1), explains why. Where the exorcism in the baptismal rite was kept, the minister who baptised spoke it. The Reformed orders dropped even that. Bentheim-Tecklenburg orders the baptismal "exorcisms, which have no ground in the Word of God", to be abolished (Sehling 22, p. 269).

**Acolyte.** Outside the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite; §16.3.4), the acolyte's tasks at the altar either lapsed or fell to the ministrants of the early Mass orders (§16.4.1–16.4.2). The training role that the Brethren gave their acolytes was filled elsewhere by the **school**. Strasbourg calls the school ministry "second after the order of priests" (§16.3.1).

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## 16.4 The liturgical roles

Most evangelical orders assume that the service is led by one minister at the altar, with the schoolmaster and boys as the choir and the sexton ringing the bells. The roles asked about are mostly absent:

- **Common:** the reader (§16.3.5).
- **Occasional:** the server or ministrant, and the assisting deacon and subdeacon at the altar.
- **Common only at funerals:** the cross-bearer, who is a schoolboy or the sexton, never a cleric.
- **Never prescribed as a role:** the thurifer, the boat-bearer, the candle-bearer and torch-bearer, and the master of ceremonies. Lights could still be carried at Brandenburg funerals (§16.4.4).

The early Mass-shaped orders of Nürnberg, Brandenburg, Pfalz-Neuburg and Regensburg are the exception. They keep assisting ministers at the altar for a time. Where those assistants are named, they are usually **ordained ministers** taking turns, not boys or men in minor orders.

### 16.4.1 Ministrants

The Nürnberg parish churches' order of 1524 keeps a *ministrant* at the altar. The priest asks him who has announced himself for communion. **Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524** (Sehling 11, p. 52):

> Nach dem alleluia fragt der priester den ministranten, ob sich jemand hab angesagt, das heilig sacrament zu empfahen.

After the alleluia the priest asketh the ministrant whether any have announced himself to receive the holy sacrament.

Elector Joachim II's order for Brandenburg (1540) has the celebrant wear a cope or surplice, not a chasuble. It allows ministrants "in deacons' coats" (dalmatics) where there are enough clergy, as in collegiate churches, monasteries and some large towns. **Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540** (Sehling 3, p. 71):

> da man es auch an kirchendienern haben kan, als in stiften und klöstern, auch in etlichen grossen stedten mag man zu solchem ampt auch ministranten in diaconröcken brauchen.

[…] where there can be had ministers of the church enough for it, as in foundations and cloisters, and also in certain great towns, ministrants in deacons' coats may also be used for such an office.

The same order keeps the "customary lights" at the hours and Masses. It abolishes only the special lights of the confraternities and guilds (Sehling 3, p. 71).

### 16.4.2 Deacon and subdeacon at the altar

Pfalz-Neuburg 1543 has the celebrant come to the altar "with his ministrants, where and when they are wont to be used". It then gives the epistle to the subdeacon, the gospel to the deacon, and the chalice to the deacon. Each of these applies only "where there are ministrants". **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 13, pp. 70–71):

> Erstlich soll der priester, so die meß halten will, sampt seinen ministranten, wo und wann man dieselben zu gebrauchen pflegt, in iren gewonlichen kirchenornaten nach gewonheit einer jeden kirchen zu dem altar gehn und anfenglich darvor kniend das Confiteor oder ein feinen bußpsalm sprechen. […] Nachvolgends sol er oder der subdiaconus, wann man ministranten hat, die epistel teutsch mit lauter, verstendlicher stimme lesen […] Darnach sol er oder der diaconus, wann man ministranten hat, das evangelion auch mit lauter, verstentlicher stimm lesen

First shall the priest which will hold the mass, together with his ministrants, where and when they are wont to be used, go to the altar in their customary church vestments after the custom of each church, and at the beginning, kneeling before it, say the Confiteor or a goodly penitential psalm. […] Afterward shall he, or the subdeacon if there be ministrants, read the epistle in

German with a loud and understandable voice [...] Thereafter shall he, or the deacon if there be ministrants, read the gospel likewise with a loud and understandable voice [...]

At the distribution (Sehling 13, p. 75):

> Desgleichen, wo man ministranten hat, sol der diaconus den kelch reichen denen, so den leib Christi genossen haben [...] Wo man aber nit ministranten hat, da sol der priester den leib des Herrn erstlich jederman reichen und darnach erst den kelch

Likewise, where there are ministrants, the deacon shall reach the cup to them which have partaken of the body of Christ [...] But where there are no ministrants, there shall the priest first reach the body of the Lord to every man, and only after that the cup.

Heilbronn's order of 1530 has the preacher stand at the rood altar "with his two deacons in surplices". The preacher speaks the words of Christ, and the deacons distribute. Heilbronn's *Diaconi* were the town's assistant preachers. **Heilbronn, *„Confessio Heilbronnensis“ und Kirchenordnung*, 1530** (Sehling 17/1, p. 285):

> Nach demselben went sich der prediger ob dem Creutzaltar mit seinen zweien Diaconis in korröken gegen dem volkh, verkundigt den thod Christi, was man suchen soll im abenntmall, denen, die dann vorhanden sind. Darnach spricht der prediger die wortt Christi uber das brott und den wein unnd nach demselben reichen die Diaconi daß sacrament von dem altar denen, so deß begeren

After the same the preacher turneth himself at the rood altar, with his two Deacons in surplices, toward the people, [and] proclaimeth the death of Christ, [and] what one ought to seek in the supper, to them that are then present. Thereafter the preacher speaketh the words of Christ over the bread and the wine; and after the same the Deacons reach the sacrament from the altar to them that desire it [...]

In both orders the deacon distributes but does not consecrate. This division of labour runs through all the orders that have an assisting deacon.

The Regensburg order of 1553, drawn up under Justus Jonas, works with a weekly rota of the town's **ordained ministers**:

- the *Wochner* (the minister on duty that week) celebrates;
- the second minister, "ministrant or deacon", says the Confiteor with him and gives the cup;
- the third reads a chapter from the pulpit and holds the houseling cloth;
- the fourth, in a surplice, holds the cloth by the cup.

**Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553** (Sehling 13, pp. 419–421):

> Erstlich so kombt der priester (das ist der minister, welcher, wie obstehet, wochner ist) sambt zwaien ministranten oder diaconen fur den altar [...] Der priester selb raicht den leib Christi dem volk auf seiner seiten, der ministrant oder diaconus (der secundus ist) raicht das bluet Christi dem volk auf der andern seiten des altars. Der diaconus aber, so tercius ist, helt das tuechlein auf des priesters seiten, der den leib raicht. Derjenig aber, so quartus ist, helt das tuechle bei dem diacono, der das bluet raicht, in einem chorrock. Wo aber kein minister vorhanden, so tuet es der prediger oder pfarherr.

First cometh the priest (that is, the minister which, as is above said, is of the week) with two ministrants or deacons before the altar [...] The priest himself reacheth the body of Christ to the people on his side; the ministrant or deacon (which is second) reacheth the blood of Christ to the people on the other side of the altar. But the deacon which is third holdeth the little cloth on the side of the priest which reacheth the body. And he which is fourth holdeth the cloth beside the deacon which reacheth the blood, in a surplice. But where no minister is at hand, then the preacher or the pastor doeth it.

The places of the ministers at the altar are treated in Chapter 2, §2.15.8.

#### 16.4.3 Levites: kept, then abolished

In the south German imperial cities, the two assistants at the altar were called **levites**, a gospeller and an epistoler. Sehling's editor notes that outside cathedrals they were in practice priests (Sehling 13, p. 391, note 6). Regensburg's first evangelical

service, described in the "True Report" of 1542, has them in full. **Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542** (Sehling 13, pp. 391, 393):

> Unter diser letanei geen drei kirchendiener, nemlich der priester, so das ambt singet, sambt zwaien leviten, nemlichen einem evangelier und einem epistler, aus dem sagra zum altar, darauf das volk gespeiset werden solle, und betet der priester sambt dem evangelier das Confiteor. So verordnet dhweil der epistler den kelch, buech, partikl und paten auf den altar. [...] Der epistler aber helt das tuchle, daruber das volk den leib Christi empfecht und, so jemants aus einfalt etwo ein ungeschickligkeit brauchte, den unterweist und bericht er, wie er sich halten solle.

During this litany three ministers of the church go out of the sacristy to the altar whereat the people is to be fed, namely, the priest which singeth the office, together with two levites, namely a gospeller and an epistoler; and the priest with the gospeller prayeth the Confiteor. Meanwhile the epistoler setteth in order the chalice, book, particles and paten upon the altar. [...] But the epistoler holdeth the little cloth over which the people receiveth the body of Christ; and if any out of simplicity should use some awkwardness, him he instructeth and informeth how he ought to behave himself.

Nürnberg's report to the council of Goslar (1528) gives the levites the reading and the exhortation. One reads and expounds a whole chapter of the Epistles "in place of the lesson". One gives the exhortation to the communicants before the altar. **Nürnberg, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 230):

> Nach solichem tritt der leviten eyner uff den predigestol und liest an stadt der lection ein gantz capittel auß Sanct Petrus, Sanct Paulsen oder Sanct Johannesen epistolen [...] Darauff alßbalde tritt der leviten eyner fur den altar und thut in teutscher sprach ein christliche ermanunge

After this one of the levites goeth up into the pulpit, and readeth in place of the lesson a whole chapter out of the epistles of Saint Peter, Saint Paul or Saint John [...] Thereupon straightway one of the levites goeth before the altar and maketh in the German tongue a christian exhortation [...]

**Abolition.** The levites, and the dalmatics and chasubles that went with them, were the target of deliberate abolition in the 1550s and 1560s. In April 1554 Nikolaus Gallus and the council of Regensburg had a declaration read to the congregation. It gives two grounds:

- The levitical garments come from the Old Testament priesthood and the papal Mass, both now ended in Christ.
- The pope now requires them as necessary to true worship, and Christian liberty must show "the contrary".

**Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554** (Sehling 13, p. 432):

> Ein ehrbar rat hat sampt uns dienern des worts für gut angesehen, das die leviten- und meßgewand bei der communion in unser christlichen kirchen alhie wie bei vielen andern hinfort genzlich abgetan sein sollen. Dasselbig aus nachvolgenden ursachen: Erstlich, das beide stück (wie zum teil die namen noch anzeigen) vom levitischen priestertum des alten testaments und von des bapsts messe in unser kirchen kommen und ihre bedeutung auf den zukünftigen Christum gehabt haben. Weil wir denn im neuen testament von gesetzen des levitischen priestertums frei und von des bapsts gotteslesterischen messe ledig sind, den cörper Christum selbs und im abendmahl nach den worten Christi nit mehr denn ein communion haben, so lassen wir billich den jüdischen schatten faren sampt demjenigen, was des bapsts messe anhanget und dienet. Zum andern sind die leviten- und meßgewand nit allein vom bapst unrecht in die christliche kirchen des neuen testaments eingefüret, sondern werden von ihm noch aufs neu geboten und als nötig zum waren gottesdienst mit aberglauben und abgöttischer meinung erfordert. Derhalben, wie wir sonst vom bapst, von seiner falschen lere und falschen gottesdienst recht abgesondert sind, also sollen wir auch hierin von ihm fort ganz sein gescheiden und zu erzeigung unser christlichen freiheit dieses fals das widerspiel beweisen.

An honourable council, together with us ministers of the word, hath thought good that the levites' and mass vestments shall henceforth be wholly done away at the communion in our christian church here, as with many others. And that for the following causes. First, that both pieces (as in part the names yet shew) came into our church from the levitical priesthood of the old testament and from the pope's mass, and had their signification upon Christ which was to come. Since then in the new testament we are free from the laws of the levitical priesthood and quit of the pope's blasphemous mass, [and] have the body, Christ himself, and in the supper, according to the words of Christ, no more than a communion, we rightly let the Jewish shadow go, together with that which hangeth upon and serveth the pope's mass. Secondly, the levites' and mass vestments were not only wrongly brought by the pope into the christian church of the new testament, but are yet commanded by him anew, and

required as necessary to the true service of God with superstitious and idolatrous opinion. Therefore, as we are otherwise rightly separated from the pope, from his false doctrine and false service of God, so shall we also herein be wholly parted from him henceforth, and, for the shewing of our christian liberty, prove the contrary in this case.

Regensburg's church order of 1567(?) records that the levites, the vestments and the altar lights were all "let fall" in the end. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?)** (Sehling 13, p. 480):

> Demnach haben wir auch die kirchenkleidung, als meßgewand, stolen, leviten usw. gleich wie auch die liechter, so von anfang der reinen lere gleichwol lange zeit in unser pfarrhe mit gehalten worden, entlich sampt den obgemelten, etlichen feiertägen lassen fallen aus ursachen, das die ding aus dem alten testament von dem levitischen priestertum, so sein ende hat, mit unverstand sind in das neue testament eingefürt und in eitel bapstisch abgötterei gewendet.

Accordingly we have also at last let fall the church vesture, as chasubles, stoles, levites etc., as also the lights, which from the beginning of the pure doctrine were nevertheless kept a long time in our parish, together with certain of the holy days above mentioned; for the causes that these things were brought without understanding out of the old testament, from the levitical priesthood, which hath its end, into the new testament, and turned into mere papistical idolatry.

The chapter order of Brandenburg-Ansbach (1565, revised 1578) forbids them outright at the clergy's chapter meetings. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78** (Sehling 11, p. 357):

> Es sollen auch keine leviten bapstischem prauch nach dargestellet werden.

Neither shall any levites be set forth after the papistical use.

#### 16.4.4 Thurifer, boat-bearer and candle-bearer

Luther's *Formula missae* leaves both candles and incense at the gospel free. **Luther, *Formula missae et communionis pro ecclesia Wittembergensi*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 5):

> Sexto sequitur evangelii lectio. Ubi nec candelas neque thurificationem prohibemus, sed nec exigimus. Esto hoc liberum.

Sixthly followeth the reading of the gospel. Wherein we neither forbid candles nor censing, but neither do we require them. Let this be free.

Lippe (1538) lists incense among the abuses to be dropped from the Mass, while it leaves vestments, albs and lights free. **Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 318):

> mit itlichen korten ceremonien, ahne water in den kelch, wirock, vele creutze tho makende unnd andere mißbruke. Averm missewant, alven, lechte, ruchellen sint friggn.

[…] with certain short ceremonies, without water in the chalice, incense, the making of many crosses, and other abuses. But chasubles, albs, lights [and] rochets are free.

No later order in the corpus takes up Luther's freedom for incense. **No order prescribes a thurifer or a boat-bearer.** Censing is mentioned only in descriptions of the old Mass, or in lists of things abolished.

Altar lights were kept in many Lutheran territories, as in Brandenburg 1540 above. But they were lit and tended by the **sexton**, and no order makes carrying them a liturgical role. **No candle-bearer (*accensor*, *ceroferarius*) or torch-bearer is prescribed**, not even at the gospel or the elevation. Regensburg let its lights fall with the levites (§16.4.3). Lights were still carried in two places outside the service. Electoral Brandenburg let the old custom of carrying lights at funerals "remain with measure" (Sehling 3, p. 81). The early Baden order of 1533 kept the sacrament carried to the sick "with light and bells going before" (Sehling 16, p. 510). Neither names who carried them.

#### 16.4.5 Cross-bearer, and the roles not found

The processional cross went with the processions themselves. Freiberg 1537 lists "going with the cross" among the human ordinances to be done away (§16.3.3). In Brandenburg it survived in the Rogation-tide procession, where it is carried before the schoolboys, the priests and the people. **Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541** (Sehling 3, p. 314):

> und hernach die processionen ordentlich halten, als am ersten ein kreuz vorher tragen, dornach die schuler, folgend die priester und hernach die man, junkfrauen und frauen

[…] and afterward hold the processions in order: as, first, to carry a cross before, thereafter the scholars, following them the priests, and after them the men, maidens and women […]

Schwäbisch Hall's church order of 1543, in its revision of 1615, allows a cross before a coffin. It must be used "not effectively but significatively", that is, as a sign that the dead died trusting in Christ's cross, not as a thing that works anything. **Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615, *Ordnung der Begrebnus*** (Sehling 17/1, p. 173):

> Inmassen auch an ihm selbst nit unrecht ist, ein Creutz vor der Leich hertragen, wann es ohne Aberglauben und Abgötterey geschicht, Nemblich also, daß es nit effective, sondern significative gebraucht wirt, anzuzeigen, daß der Todte auff das Creutz Jesu Christi abgestorben.

Inasmuch as it is also not in itself wrong to carry a cross before the corpse, when it is done without superstition and idolatry; namely so, that it be used not effectively but significatively, to shew that the dead man died upon the cross of Jesus Christ.

No order makes the **crucifer** an office, but several name the bearer, and he is never a cleric:

- **A schoolboy.** In Anhalt's order of the German hymns (before 1551) "a boy from the school shall carry a cross on a staff before the procession" at burials (Sehling 2, p. 555). At Prenzlau in 1557 the cross is "carried before by the scholars" (Sehling 3, p. 261).
- **The sexton.** In Waldeck in 1556 "the sexton or *Opfermann* shall go with a cross", followed by the schoolboys, the schoolmaster and the pastor (Sehling 9, p. 256).

In Electoral Brandenburg the cross went before the schoolboys and the priests at every funeral (Sehling 3, p. 81). Freiberg in 1538 required a crucifix at every burial (Sehling 1, p. 468). The full evidence on who walked in processions and what was carried is in Chapter 13 §13.18.4.

**Not found.** The corpus contains no prescribed role of **candle-bearer** (*accensor*, *ceroferarius*), **torch-bearer**, **boat-bearer** or **master of ceremonies**. The nearest thing to the last is the **cantor** or schoolmaster, who directs the choir and the sung parts of the service. He is a school officer, not a liturgical minister. The orders of service are addressed to the pastor himself, and they set out the ceremonies he is to observe.

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## 16.5 The diaconate

The diaconate survived in three forms, and an order often has more than one of them under the same name:

- the **Lutheran *Diaconus***: an ordained assistant minister of the word and sacraments (§16.5.1);
- the **liturgical deacon**: an assistant at the altar, normally himself one of the ordained ministers (§16.4.2–16.4.3);
- the **lay deacon of the poor**: an elected steward of alms and church goods, based on Acts 6 (§16.5.2–16.5.3).

### 16.5.1 The Lutheran *Diaconus*: an assistant minister, ordained like a pastor

In the Lutheran town churches the *Diaconus* (also *Helfer*, *Kaplan*, *Capellan*) is a second or third minister, and the *Subdiaconus* (§16.3.3) a third or fourth. Each preaches, baptises, hears confession, communes the sick and gives the cup at the altar. Halle provides each of its three parish churches with "a pastor and two deacons, who are all fit to preach, to reach the sacrament and to perform other church business". **Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?)** (Sehling 2, p. 442):

> dass itzt bestelte oft ernannte drei pfar kirchen S. Mariae, S. Ulrici und Mauritii, und mit drei personen, nämlichen einen pfarher und zweien diaconis versehen und erhalten werde, die alle zu predigen, sacrament zu reichen und andere kirchengeschäfte zuverrichten tüchtig sind.

[…] that the three parish churches now established and oft named, St Mary, St Ulrich and [St] Maurice, be provided and maintained with three persons, namely one pastor and two deacons, which are all fit to preach, to reach the sacrament, and to perform other business of the church.

**The same ordination.** The *Diaconus* is ordained with the same rite as the pastor. Electoral Saxony's form for ordaining and investing "a new minister of the church" names "the new pastor or deacon" throughout. The superintendent lays his right hand on him, as a ceremony "of christian liberty". He then "ordains, confirms and establishes" him, "by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and curate of souls of this congregation". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, pp. 382–383):

> Unter dem gesang sol der superintendens vor den altar treten, den neuen pfarren oder diacon zu sich berufen, und vor ihm zu dem gebet niederknien lassen […] sol sich der superintendens vor dem altar gegen dem volk wenden, und wie (nach christlicher freiheit, so von dem herrn Christo der kirchen in eusserlichen mittelmessigen ceremonien gegeben) gebreuchlich, sein rechte hand dem neuen pfarrer oder diacon auf sein blos heubt legen, und also sagen. Dieweil wir im heiligen geist versamlet, gott unsern himlischen vater durch Jesum Christum unsern herrn und heiland uber dich angerufen und gebeten, und deshalben nicht zweifeln, er werde uns, laut seiner göttlichen zusagung, gnediglich erhört und gewert haben, demnach so ordne, confirmire und bestetige ich dich, aus göttlichem befehl und ordnung, zu einem diener und seelsorger dieser gemein

During the singing the superintendent shall step before the altar, call the new pastor or deacon to him, and cause him to kneel before him to prayer […] the superintendent shall turn himself before the altar toward the people, and, as is customary (according to the christian liberty given by the Lord Christ to the church in outward indifferent ceremonies), lay his right hand upon the bare head of the new pastor or deacon, and say thus: Forasmuch as we, gathered in the Holy Ghost, have called upon and prayed God our heavenly Father through Jesus Christ our Lord and Saviour over thee, and therefore doubt not that he, according to his divine promise, hath graciously heard and granted us; therefore I ordain, confirm and establish thee, by divine command and ordinance, to be a minister and curate of souls of this congregation […]

**A step, not an order.** The diaconate is normally the first post of a young minister, but it is not a necessary stage. The same order allows a candidate of exceptional gifts to be made a pastor "without the means of the diaconate". **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung*, 1580** (Sehling 1, pp. 381–382):

> Da aber einer im examine dermassen gelert, geschickt und erfaren, und mit gaben zuleren ausgerüstet, und im predigen schon geübet, darzu der rituum ecclesiae notdürftiglich berichtet erfunden, mag mit demselben dispensiret, und solche person ohne mittel des diaconats, zu einem pfarrer verordnet und angenommen werden.

But if one be found in the examination so learned, apt and experienced, and furnished with gifts to teach, and already practised in preaching, and moreover sufficiently instructed in the rites of the church, then may there be dispensation with him, and such a person may be appointed and received to be a pastor without the means of the diaconate.

This Lutheran diaconate is therefore a **rank in one ministry**, distinguished by benefice, seniority and duties. It is not a sacramental grade. The *Diaconus* could do everything the pastor did. He was subject to the pastor, as the pastor was to the superintendent, by "human" order (§16.5.4).

The deacon's duties alongside the pastor are treated in Chapter 15, §15.3.5.

### 16.5.2 Lay deacons of the poor in the Lutheran orders

Bugenhagen's orders for Brunswick (1528), Hamburg (1529) and Lübeck (1531) created the most widespread lay diaconate of the Reformation. These are the **deacons of the common chest** (*diakene der schatkaste*) and **deacons of the poor** (*diakene der armen*): honest burghers elected for a term to keep the treasury, collect and distribute alms, and look after the ministers' maintenance. Bugenhagen grounds the office on Acts 6 and the qualifications in 1 Timothy 3, which he expounds clause by clause. In passing he equates bishops and preachers. **Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528** (Sehling 6/1, p. 449):

> dat de diakene scholen syn redelick, de eyn gut ruchte hebben, dat se alse ehrlike frame lude in allen dingen nicht unrecht handelen. Item dat se nicht twetungich syn, wen wo kan me deme sulk gelt unde denst der armen bevehlen, de gerne legen unde achterkosen, vor mynen ogenen wit seggen unde anderswör swart. Sulke plegen ock hader unde afval wedder de bischoppe edder predicanten (welk alle eyn dink is) anrichten etc. Item: Nicht wynsuchtich edder eyn drunkenbolt, wente sulk eyn wert syne collatie söken van der armen gelde

[…] that the deacons shall be honest, such as have a good report, that as honourable, godly people they deal not wrongly in any thing. Item, that they be not double-tongued; for how can one commit such money and the service of the poor to him that loveth to lie and to backbite, [that] saith white before mine eyes and elsewhere black? Such are wont also to stir up strife and falling away against the bishops or preachers (which is all one thing), etc. Item: not given to wine, or a drunkard; for such an one will seek his collation out of the money of the poor […]

**What they might not do.** Bugenhagen's deacons do not minister the word. In the early Church Stephen and Lawrence comforted the poor with God's word, but "with us" the visiting of the sick belongs to the preachers, and "our deacons only procure money from the common chest for the needy" (§16.3.3).

**Collegiate control.** In Hamburg 3 or 4 deacons alone may not lend or make any substantial grant from the poor's goods. That is done only when "the sixteen deacons" meet on Saturday. **Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529** (Sehling 5, p. 535):

> Vorlenen edder wat stadliken geven van dussem gude der armen schollen sick dre edder veer diakene nicht understaen, sunder id schall scheen, wen des sonnavendes de sostein diakene edder de meisten van en, wen jo etlike nicht kamen konnen, tosamende sint

To lend, or to give any thing of substance, out of these goods of the poor, three or four deacons shall not take upon themselves; but it shall be done when on the Saturday the sixteen deacons, or the most of them if some cannot come, are together […]

Lübeck's order of 1531 follows Hamburg's. Every Saturday the three youngest deacons of each parish, who hold the keys, empty the poor chest and carry its contents to St Mary's (Sehling 5, p. 359).

Hamburg's deacons also hire and dismiss the sexton and the organists. They care for the widows and orphans of deceased preachers. They give yearly gifts to the midwives, who in turn report poor women in childbed to them (Sehling 5, pp. 512–513).

**Other names for the same office.** The lay deacon of the poor appears under several names:

- ***Leviten*** in the Land Hadeln. They collect at the church door during the general prayer, go from house to house once a year for corn, admit the deserving poor to the hospitals "by the counsel and with the will of the pastor", and maintain the preachers and the poor from the common chest. **Hadeln, *Hadelner Kirchenordnung*, 1526** (Sehling 5, p. 472):

> dat de leviten, alse men se nöhmet, de predicanten und rechte armen darmit schölen underholden. […] Alle sondage und hoge feste schall ein van den leviten mit der bede umme gan in der kerken, dewile de predicante up dem stole steit und deit dat gemene gebedt. […] Na rade unde mit willen des pastors schölen de leviten in de gasthuse nehmen edder hospitale andere hussarmen, dat rechte armen sint.

[…] that the levites, as they are called, shall maintain therewith the preachers and the true poor. […] Every Sunday and high feast one of the levites shall go about with the bag in the church while the preacher standeth in the pulpit and maketh the common prayer. […] By the counsel and with the will of the pastor the levites shall take into the guest-houses or hospitals other house-poor, which are truly poor.

- ***Subdiaconi oder Bittherren*** at St Wenzel's in Naumburg. There are twelve: three from the council and the rest from the community. They stand at the church doors with collecting boards. **Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537** (Sehling 2, p. 64):

> Von den bitthern. Darnach sollen zwölf subdiaconi oder bittherrn, drei aus dem rathe, sieben aus der gemeine verordnet werden, under welchen alle feiertage sechse für der kirchenthür, so balde die predigt aus ist, vor jeder thuer einer mit einer tafel stehen und den armen leuten das almosen bitten

Of the beggar-lords. Thereafter shall twelve subdeacons, or beggar-lords, be appointed, three out of the council, seven out of the community; of whom every holy day six shall stand before the church doors as soon as the sermon is out, before each door one, with a board, and beg the alms for the poor people […]

- ***Diaconi*** in Pomerania. At Pyritz (1539) two come from the council and two from the guilds. They are expressly **not** put under oath, but they must render account yearly. **Pyritz, *Abschied*, 1539** (Sehling 4, p. 519):

> Visitatores wollen verständigt sein, aus welchem corpore die diaconi erwählt werden. Darauf geantwort, dass zwei aus dem rathe und zwei von den werken zu diaconis erwählt, aber nicht mit keinem eide beladen werden und müssen alle jahre vor dem rathe zu Pyritz rechnung thun.

The visitors desire to be informed out of what body the deacons are chosen. Whereto answer was made, that two out of the council and two from the guilds are chosen to be deacons, but are not laden with any oath, and must every year render account before the council at Pyritz.

The Pomeranian synod of 1574 requires the opposite, an **oath**. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 491):

> II. Pastores attendant, ut idonei eligantur diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum, et ut iidem jurejurando fidem suam ecclesiae vel pauperibus, juxta ordinationem ecclesiasticam obstringant, et quotannis, praesente magistratu et pastore, rationem reddant.

II. Let the pastors take heed that fit deacons of the church and of the poor be chosen, and that the same bind their faith to the church or to the poor by oath, according to the church order, and yearly render account in the presence of the magistrate and the pastor.

- ***Diaconi, dat is der armen dieners*** in Lippe (1538). Every parish church is to "ordain" them and set up a common chest. The word *ordiniren* here means no more than to appoint. **Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538** (Sehling 21, p. 335):

> Hirumb is nodig einer ideren kespelkirchen, diaconos, dat is der armen dieners, tho ordinirende und einenn gemeinenn kasten anthorichtende

Therefore it is needful for every parish church to ordain deacons, that is, servants of the poor, and to set up a common chest […]

The office spread to the Lutheran stranger churches. The **Dutch congregation of the Augsburg Confession at Frankfurt** founded its poor chest in 1585 and chose as its first *diaconi* Michael Bode and Lorenz, "the schoolmaster here". **Frankfurt, *Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C.*, 1585** (Lutheran; Sehling 9, p. 604):

> indem sie zu den ersten diaconis erwählet Michael Bode und Lorenz, allhiesigen schulmeister, und zu deputirten die herrn Arnd van Nieden, Peter van Leyden und Renatus Verbeke, absens, welche im nahmen des herrn dieses ihr amt angenommen haben.

[…] in that they chose for the first deacons Michael Bode and Lorenz, the schoolmaster here, and for deputies the lords Arnd van Nieden, Peter van Leyden and Renatus Verbeke (absent), which in the name of the Lord have taken upon them this their office.

Sehling's editors of the Hildesheim volume point out that Bugenhagen counted the maintenance of ministers and the poor as part of "divine order". They conclude that the deacon's office must, by its function, be of divine right (§16.5.4).

### 16.5.3 Hesse, the Reformed churches and the Bohemian Brethren: deacons as an ordained lay office

In the Hessian order of 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and in the Reformed orders, the deacon of the poor becomes one of the **standing offices** of the congregation, alongside the ministers of the word and the elders. He is chosen by the Spirit's own rule (Acts 6:3; 1 Timothy 3:8–12), put on probation (1 Timothy 3:10), and **ordained**.

Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) gives the scriptural qualifications. **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 210):

> hat uns der heilig Geist selbst gezeiget, was vor leut zu diesem ampt erwelet und gebraucht werden sollen. Man muß erwelen, sagen die aposteln (Act. 6, 3), menner, die ein gut gerucht haben und vol heiliges Geistes und weisheit seint. Und der heilig apostel Paulus, 1. Tim. 3 (8f. 12), die diacon sollen erbar sein, nit zweizüngig, nicht weinseufer, nicht unehrliche handtirung treiben, die das geheimnis des glaubens in reinem gewissen haben, eines weibes mann […] und die ihr kinder und ganzes hausgesind wol regiren. (a. R.: Probatio) Welche nun erwelet seint, die sollen mit den andern, so in diesem ampt sein, ein zeitlang sich uben und brauchen, damit sie sich zu diesem ampt zuvor bereiten und geschickt machen, auf daß auch hiemit ihr glaub, fleiß und aufrichtigkeit an ihn probirt und bewert werde.

[…] the Holy Ghost himself hath shewed us what manner of men should be chosen and used for this office. Ye must choose, say the apostles (Acts 6:3), men which have a good report and are full of the Holy Ghost and wisdom. And the holy apostle Paul, 1

Timothy 3: the deacons shall be grave, not double-tongued, not given to wine, not plying a dishonest trade, which hold the mystery of the faith in a pure conscience, the husband of one wife […] and which rule their children and whole household well. (In the margin: Probation.) They then which are chosen shall exercise and employ themselves for a time with the others which are in this office, that they may prepare and make themselves apt for this office beforehand, to the end that hereby also their faith, diligence and uprightness may be proved and tried in them.

Hesse (1566, Moderate Reformed) holds that the apostles ordained deacons "with common prayer and laying on of hands". It therefore ordains both elders and deacons in their own church, while noting that the deacon's office "is not equal to the service of the elders". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, pp. 207–208):

> Es haben auch die aposteln mit dem gemeinen gebet und auflegung der hende die diacon ordiniret und bestetiget, Act. 6 [1-6], welches ampt doch dem dienst der eltesten beiweilen nicht gleich ist. Es sollen aber alweg diese eltesten und auch die diacon in derselbigen kirchen ordiniret werden, welcher sie dienen sollen, und dies soll entweder der superintendens, wan er daselbst visitiret, oder sonst irgents ein pfarherr sampt einem oder zweien dienern des worts verrichten.

The apostles also ordained and confirmed the deacons with common prayer and laying on of hands, Acts 6; which office nevertheless is by no means equal to the service of the elders. But these elders, and the deacons also, shall always be ordained in the same church which they are to serve; and this shall be performed either by the superintendent, when he visiteth there, or else by some pastor together with one or two ministers of the word.

**Micron's *Ordinancien*** (Reformed). These are the order of the Dutch stranger church in London (1554), as printed for Norden in East Frisia in 1565. They set "four deacons or ministers of the poor, after the apostolic order" beside the elders. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 583):

> Bald darnach haben wir auch vier diaken oder diener der armen nach der apostolischen ordnung mit bewilligung der gemeine angenommen.

Soon after we also received, with the consent of the congregation, four deacons or ministers of the poor after the apostolic order.

The deacons are confirmed with a form modelled on that for the elders (§16.6.3). They are presented to the congregation and questioned:

- whether they feel the inward witness of the Spirit;
- whether they hold the prophetic and apostolic doctrine sufficient;
- whether they will gather and distribute the alms faithfully "without respect of persons";
- whether they will submit to Christian discipline.

The congregation prays, "as thou didst give thy Spirit to Stephen". Then hands are laid on them. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565, chapter VII, "Form der bestetigung der diaken oder almosenpfleger"** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 597–598):

> Wollet ihr nicht die almussen zum nutz der armen fleisig samlen und die versamleten treulich und weißlich den armen außteilen, und insonderheit den haußgenossen des glaubens, one einigs eusserliches ansehen der person, sonder allein nach eines jeden noturft und armut? Sie antworten: Ja, wir, durch die gnade Gottes. […] Wann das gebet volendet ist, werden ihnen die hende aufgelegt, und der diener spricht mit heller stimme also: Gott der Herr und unser himlischer Vater, der euch zu dem dienst der diakeney beruffen hat, der regiere euch gendiglich mit seiner göttlichen kraft, weißheit und gütigkeit

Will ye not diligently gather the alms for the profit of the poor, and faithfully and wisely distribute that which is gathered unto the poor, and especially unto the household of faith, without any outward respect of the person, but only according to each one's need and poverty? They answer: Yea, we will, by the grace of God. […] When the prayer is ended, hands are laid upon them, and the minister saith with a clear voice thus: God the Lord and our heavenly Father, which hath called you to the service of the diaconate, govern you graciously with his divine power, wisdom and goodness […]

Sehling's editor notes that in **London** (Reformed) the elders and the deacons had been installed with prayer and laying on of hands since 1550. In **Emden** (Reformed) laying on of hands "is not attested", and the deacons there were apparently not installed after the same pattern as the elders (Sehling 7/1, pp. 554–555, editor's introduction).

**Without laying on of hands.** Several Reformed orders install deacons with no laying on of hands:

- **Kurpfalz (1563)**, followed by **Wittgenstein (1581)** and **Bentheim-Tecklenburg** (1588/1619), all Reformed. They have "pious and godly men, whom they call *diaconi* or almoners", elected per 1 Timothy 3:8. They collect the alms on Sundays and distribute them, and are confirmed "with the knowledge and will of the pastors and appointed seniors". No laying on of hands is mentioned. **Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619** (Reformed; Sehling 22, p. 276):

> fromme und gottselige Männer, die man Diaconos oder Almusenpfleger nennet, erwehlet und mit wissen und willen der Pastorn und verordneten Senioren bestettigt werden, vermug der Lehr und gebrauchs der H. Aposteln

[…] pious and godly men, whom men call Deacons or Almoners, be chosen, and confirmed with the knowledge and will of the Pastors and the appointed Seniors, according to the doctrine and use of the holy Apostles […]

- **Nassau-Dillenburg (1582)** (Reformed). Here the deacon is the fourth of four offices: ministers, doctors, seniors and deacons. The presbytery elects the seniors, the deacons of the poor and the sextons (*aeditui*), and the classis confirms them. The minister alone receives "confirmation or ordination". **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 23 January 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 160):

> Officia sunt quadruplicia, alia ministrorum, alia doctorum, alia seniorum, alia diaconorum. […] 4. Vocatio ministrorum fiat iudicio classis et aliquot seniorum, ad quam pertinent haec quatuor: electio, examen, approbatio et confirmatio seu ordinatio. […] 5. Quod ad seniores, diaconos pauperum et aedituos eligendos, potestas eligendi sit penes presbyterium, qui postea suffragio classici conventus confirmandi ac diligenter de officio admonendi erunt.

The offices are fourfold: some of ministers, some of doctors, some of seniors, some of deacons. […] 4. Let the calling of ministers be made by the judgement of the classis and of some seniors; whereunto pertain these four: election, examination, approbation, and confirmation or ordination. […] 5. As touching the choosing of seniors, deacons of the poor and sextons, let the power of choosing be with the presbytery; who afterward shall be confirmed by the vote of the classical assembly and be diligently admonished of [their] office.

**The Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite). Their deacon is something else: an ordained **clerical** grade between acolyte and minister. The deacons are "older acolytes", preparing for the ministry. The order defends the grade as kept "constantly in the primitive church", which must not be cast out though Antichrist abused it. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 276):

> Diaconi sunt adultiores acoluthi, futuro ministerio iam iam sese praeparantes. Hos fratrum ministri pro administris, sive adiutoribus, habent, apostolorum exemplo, Act. VI. v. 2. et Philipp. I. 1. Quamuis enim ab apostolis primario ad mensarum ministeria ordinati erant; constat tamen et praedicasse ipsos, et baptizasse (ut Stephanus, Act. VI. 10. et Philippus Act. VIII. 5. 12. 35. 38.) et ad gradum superiorem, ministerii nempe seu presbyterii, promotos fuisse, 1. Timoth. III. 13. Itaque gradus hic diaconatus in primitiva ecclesia constanter fuit servatus: ut ex conciliorum canonibus patet. Quem proinde, etiamsi ab antichristo cum ceteris in abusum tractus sit, ab ecclesia eliminari non convenit.

Deacons are the older acolytes, now presently preparing themselves for the future ministry. These the ministers of the brethren have for assistants or helpers, after the example of the apostles, Acts 6:2 and Philippians 1:1. For although they were ordained by the apostles primarily to the ministry of tables, yet it is certain that they both preached and baptised (as Stephen, Acts 6:10, and Philip, Acts 8:5, 12, 35, 38) and were promoted to a higher grade, namely of the ministry or presbytery, 1 Timothy 3:13. Therefore this grade of the diaconate was constantly kept in the primitive church, as appeareth from the canons of the councils. Which therefore, although it hath been drawn into abuse by the antichrist with the rest, it is not fitting to cast out of the church.

What the Brethren's deacons did (same page):

- study theology;
- teach the young the rudiments;
- practise preaching;
- baptise "as often as the pastor shall command".

At a crowded communion they help distribute both the bread and the cup, but with one limit: only a minister "having the power of the keys" pronounces the absolution and recites the words of institution. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576**

(Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 276):

> Quoties frequentiori coetu sacra coena administratur, nec sufficientes adsunt ministri, adhibentur etiam diaconi ad distribuendum, nonsolum calicem, sed et panem; ita tamen, ut non nisi minister, clavium potestatem habens, absolutionem populo annuntiet, et verba institutionis solemniter praemittat.

As often as the holy supper is administered in a more numerous assembly, and sufficient ministers are not present, the deacons also are employed to distribute not only the cup but also the bread; yet so that none but a minister having the power of the keys announce the absolution to the people and solemnly set forth before the words of institution.

They are ordained before the synod, with an examination by the seniors, a vow, prayer and the **laying on of hands**, "Acts 6:6". **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Diaconorum ordinatio"** (Hussite; Sehling 4, p. 279):

> 3. Illi Christo et ecclesiae voto se obstringunt. 4. Preces pro ipsis fiunt, ordinatorque manuum impositione eos confirmat, Act. VI. 6. 5. Offerunt novi diaconi senioribus et ministris obedientiae sanctae; priores vero diaconi illis societatis, dextram. 6. Benedictione actus clauditur.

3. They bind themselves to Christ and the church by a vow. 4. Prayers are made for them, and the ordainer confirmeth them by the laying on of hands, Acts 6:6. 5. The new deacons offer to the seniors and ministers the right hand of holy obedience; and the former deacons [offer] to them [the right hand] of fellowship. 6. The act is closed with a blessing.

#### 16.5.4 Divine right or human right?

**The question as the church orders put it.** No order asks whether the diaconate is a separate *order* by divine right in the Roman sense. The orders ask two other questions:

1. Is there one ministry of the word, of which bishop, pastor and deacon are grades?
2. Is the deacon of the poor a lasting institution of the apostles?

**One ministry; grades by human right.** The orders consistently say that bishop, presbyter and pastor are one office:

- Homberg 1526 (Moderate Reformed): "bishops, or presbyters" (§16.3.2).
- Bugenhagen 1528: "bishops or preachers (which is all one thing)" (§16.5.2).
- Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539. It describes the ancient Church as installing a minister "by one or two of the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors". It says that it now has "certain of the nearest pastors or elders" lay hands on the new minister. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“*, 1539** (Sehling 18, p. 63):

> das die gemein einen welet, der ward von einem oder zweien der nechsten bischoffen, die man auch pastores oder pfarher nennet, eingesetzt und bestetigt. […] Die nu in lere und leben zu diesem ampt thetig erfunden wurden, denen haben wyr furgemelt ettlich der nechsten pfarher oder eltesten in der gemein gottes, die hend auff das haupt gelegt und gebetten, das der heilig geist die diener des worts in Christlicher lere und leben erleuchten und erhalten wölle.

[…] that the congregation chose one, who was set in office and confirmed by one or two of the nearest bishops, whom men also call pastors or parsons. […] Those then which were found apt for this office in doctrine and life, upon them have certain of the nearest pastors or elders in the congregation of God, as aforesaid, laid hands upon the head, and prayed that the Holy Ghost would enlighten and preserve the ministers of the word in christian doctrine and life.

Where distinctions within the ministry are defended, they are defended as **human order for the sake of good order**. Melanchthon's *Wittenberg Reformation* (1545) keeps bishops "as a grade above other priests" so that, "so far as human foresight can consider", there may be a lasting order. **Ernestine Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545** (Sehling 1, p. 217):

> unter diesen seelsorgern muss dennoch eine ordnung sein; sie haben nicht alle gleiche gaben, können nicht alle richter sein in schweren artikeln der lehre; sie können nicht alle die gericht ordnen und halten. […] und die selbigen ort müssen mit personen und unterhaltung also versorgt sein, dass es, so viel menschliche fürsichtigkeit bedenken kann, eine beständige ordnung sei. Darum müssen bischofe, als ein grad über andre priester, sein

[…] among these curates of souls there must nevertheless be an order; they have not all like gifts, they cannot all be judges in weighty articles of doctrine; they cannot all order and hold the courts. […] and the same places must be so provided with persons and maintenance that there be, so far as human foresight can consider, a lasting order. Therefore must there be bishops, as a grade above other priests […]

The same text sets "divine and eternal right" apart from "human, transitory ordinance of things indifferent" (Sehling 1, p. 218). The Lutheran *Diaconus*, the *Subdiaconus* and the superintendent all stand on the second footing. Electoral Saxony can therefore dispense a candidate from the diaconate altogether (§16.5.1). Its ordination rite also calls the laying on of hands a ceremony of "christian liberty", while it calls the ministry itself a "divine command and ordinance".

**The deacon of the poor as apostolic.** The lay deacon of the poor is, by contrast, defended as apostolic in origin:

- **Homberg** (1526, Moderate Reformed; §16.3.2) knows only "bishops, or presbyters, and deacons of the poor".
- **Strasbourg** (1539, Moderate Reformed; §16.3.1) says the deacon alone of the lower grades was instituted "by the Holy Ghost through the Apostles". Its list of the three ministries that every church needs "even today" includes "the care of the poor".
- **Hesse 1566** (Moderate Reformed) and **Micron** (Reformed) cite Acts 6 and 1 Timothy 3. They say the Holy Ghost "himself hath shewed" what men should be chosen, and they ordain deacons as the apostles did.
- **The Bohemian Brethren** (Hussite) hold that the diaconate "was constantly kept in the primitive church" and must not be cast out. In practice, though, they treat it as a probationary step towards the presbyterate.

Of Bugenhagen, the editors of the Hildesheim volume write (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 811, editor's introduction):

> Bemerkenswert ist, daß Bugenhagen in seiner Schleswig-Holsteinischen KO von 1542 und in seiner Wolfenbüttler KO von 1543 die Versorgung der Kirchen- und Schuldiener sowie auch der Armen zur göttlichen Ordnung zählt, der er die menschliche Ordnung gegenüberstellt. Von daher, nach seiner Funktion, muß demnach das Diakonenamt göttlichen Rechts sein. Es steht in der göttlichen Rechtsordnung neben dem Predigtamt!

It is noteworthy that Bugenhagen, in his Schleswig-Holstein church order of 1542 and in his Wolfenbüttel church order of 1543, reckoneth the maintenance of the ministers of church and school, and also of the poor, to the divine order, over against which he setteth the human order. From this, by its function, the office of deacon must accordingly be of divine right. It standeth in the divine order of right beside the office of preaching!

**Lay deacons.** In this sense **every** Lutheran deacon of the common chest, and every Reformed deacon, was a **lay deacon**. He was a man who kept his trade and served a term, elected by council and congregation or by the presbytery, and he had no part in preaching or the sacraments. The Lutheran *Diaconus*, by contrast, was never a layman. The Bohemian deacon was a cleric in training.

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## 16.6 Elders

**Two kinds of elders.** Almost every order that speaks of governing elders starts from 1 Timothy 5:17, "the elders that rule well […] especially they who labour in the word and doctrine". From that verse it distinguishes two kinds of elder (*presbyter*, *senior*, *Eltester*):

- those who **labour in the word**: the ministers;
- those who **only govern**: the lay elders.

**Lineage.** The lay elder came into the German orders through Bucer, at Strasbourg and in Hesse (both Moderate Reformed). It was then generalised in the Reformed orders of East Frisia, Kurpfalz, Nassau and the Wetterau counties.

**In the Lutheran orders** "elder" is either a churchwarden without spiritual jurisdiction or a senior pastor (§16.6.5).

### 16.6.1 Strasbourg: the disciplinary *seniores*

The Strasbourg examination order of about 1539 (Moderate Reformed) already speaks of a second "order of presbyters", those "employed only for the discipline of the church" (§16.3.1). Its authority is twofold:

- the elders of the synagogue;
- Ambrose on 1 Timothy 5. Ambrose complains that such elders had lapsed through "the sloth or rather the pride of the teachers, who alone wish to seem something".

Marbach's Lutheran church order of 1553 identifies the city's *Kirchenpfleger* with those *seniores*. They are elected to oversee the "whole householding of the church", which the preachers cannot manage alone. It reads the "church" of Matthew 18 as these elected men, not the whole assembly. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Marbach, 1553, "Von den kirchenpflegern und irem ampt"** (Sehling 20/1, p. 441):

> Auß der Apostel geschicht ist zu sehen, das in der ersten christlichen kirchen neben den aposteln, so das evangelium verkündigt haben, etliche von der gemein dazu erwellet und verordnet sind, die da ein sonderlich auffsehen haben solten, damit allentalben recht haußgehalten, niemands nicht gottselig nach seinem beruff zu leben versaumpt und also gute ordnung in der kirchen als im hauß Gottes gehaltenn würde, die sie seniores und presbyteros genennt haben. […] Derenhalben der herr Christus, Matth. 18 [15-18], die unbußfertigen und hartneckigen heist der kirchenn anzeigen, das sie von deren gestrafft und zu warer bekerung vermanet werden. Die kirche aber versthet der herre nicht die gantze gemein, wie die das wort zuhören zusamen kompt, sonder die jenigen, so ordenlicher weiß von solcher versamlung darzu erwölet und geben sind, in namen unnd von wegen der kirchen allerley fürgefalne kirchen sachen zu verhandlen

Out of the Acts of the Apostles it is to be seen that in the first christian church, beside the apostles which preached the gospel, certain were chosen and ordained thereto by the congregation, which should have a special oversight, that everywhere house might be rightly kept, that none might neglect to live godly according to his calling, and so good order be kept in the church as in the house of God; whom they named seniores and presbyteri. […] Therefore the Lord Christ, Matthew 18, biddeth that the impenitent and obstinate be told to the church, that they may be rebuked by it and admonished to true conversion. But by the church the Lord understandeth not the whole congregation as it cometh together to hear the word, but those which in orderly wise are chosen and given thereto by such assembly, to treat in the name and on behalf of the church all manner of church matters that fall out […]

#### 16.6.2 Hesse: elders elected, "sanctified" and finally ordained

**The Ziegenhain discipline order (1539)** (Moderate Reformed), written under Bucer's influence, introduces elders into every Hessian congregation. They are chosen by the church "according to the canon of Paul", as the ministers are. It would be good, the order says, to confirm them publicly "with prayer and exhortation" and so to "sanctify their office". The civil authority is to uphold their office as the most necessary "after the office of teaching". **Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 103):

> Diese eltesten solle jede kirche, wie auch die diener des wortes mit getreuem ufsehen auf den canonem Pauli welen. Und wer auch gut, daß man sie in der kirchen mit offentlichem gebet und vermanung zu ihnen den eltesten, ihres ampts fleißig zu warten, zu der gemein, denselbigen eltesten im Herren herzlich zu gehorchen, bestetigete und ihr ampt also heiligte. Dero ampt und dienst auch die oberkeit getreulich erheben und darob halten soll, als ob dem notwendigsten und heilsamsten dienst und ampt, so nach dem ampt der leer in der kirchen sein mag.

These elders shall every church choose, as also the ministers of the word, with faithful regard to the canon of Paul. And it were good also that they should be confirmed in the church with public prayer and exhortation (to them, the elders, to attend diligently to their office; to the congregation, to obey the same elders heartily in the Lord), and their office so be sanctified. Whose office and service the magistracy also shall faithfully exalt and uphold, as the most necessary and wholesome service and office that may be in the church after the office of teaching.

**The Hessian church order of 1566** (Moderate Reformed) makes the elders a permanent college in every parish. The superintendent's instructions open with this (Sehling 8, p. 195):

> Das erste ist, daß in allen kirchen euers zirks seniores, das ist eltesten, erwelet und ordinirt werden, welche euch beide an diesem ort und den andern pfarherrn in ihren kirchen mit rat und tat und all ihrem vermögen behülflich seien, mit welchen ihr auch von allen sachen, so im kirchenregiment fürfallen, ratschlagen und bedechtlich von allen dingen zum furderlichsten teilen und handlen mögen. Davon sagt also Lucas (Act. 14,23): Sie ordneten hin und her eltesten in der gemein, beteten und fasteten und befolhen sie dem Herrn, an den sie gleubig worden waren.

The first is, that in all churches of your district seniors, that is, elders, be chosen and ordained, which may be helpful both to you in this place and to the other pastors in their churches with counsel and deed and all their power; with whom ye may also take counsel of all matters which fall out in the government of the church, and advisedly treat of all things with all speed. Thereof saith Luke thus (Acts 14:23): They ordained elders here and there in the congregation, prayed and fasted, and commended them to the Lord on whom they believed.

**Election and qualifications.** The order appeals to Ambrose for the antiquity of the office. The ministers, together with men of the council and the congregation, elect the elders by vote (Acts 14:23). The elders must be of the same zeal and life as preachers, "only that they need not be so excellently learned". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566, "Wie man die eltesten zur verwaltung der kirchen erwelen und ordiniren sol"** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 207):

> Darumb sollen in einer jeden kirchen die diener derselbigen gemein sampt etlichen, beid vom rat und aus der gemein darzu verordnet, diese eltesten erwelen. Von der form und weis der erwelung findet man Act. 14 [23], daß es gemeinlich durch suffragia und stimme geschehen. Zu diesem ampt aber muß man eben solche leut, so viel den eifer und das leben betrifft, erwelen und haben, wie auch zum predigampt, on allein, daß sie nicht dürfen also vortrefflich gelert sein.

Therefore in every church the ministers of the same congregation, together with certain appointed thereto both from the council and from the congregation, shall choose these elders. Of the form and manner of the election it is found in Acts 14 that it was done commonly by suffrages and voices. But to this office one must choose and have even such people, so far as concerneth zeal and life, as for the office of preaching; save only that they need not be so excellently learned.

**Their charge.** The ordination address sets the elders "beside the bishops", placed by the Holy Ghost to rule the church. They are to assist the ministers as councillors assist a burgomaster. Above all they are to guard against falsification of doctrine, whether by the public preachers or by "false teachers and wolves". **Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 208):

> Ihr habt gehort, mein geliebten im Herrn, daß neben den bischoffen auch eltesten vom h. Geist zur verwaltung der kirchen Gottes gesetzt seind. Darumb will es euch gebüren, daß ihr sonderlich große sorge tragt und darauf geflissen seid, wie die kirche wol möge regirt werden, und daß ihr den andern dienern, so im wort arbeiten, in allen dingen mit treuem rat und hülf forderlich seid, gleich wie sich dan auch dapfere und weise radsherrn gegen dem burgemeister halten, wo ein gute ordnung in gemeinem nutz soll angerichtet werden. (1) Vor allen dingen aber solt ihr sampt den andern kirchendienern mit höchsten fleiß verhüten, daß nicht etwan ein verfelschung der lehr, entweder durch die, so in der kirchen offentlich predigen, oder durch falsche lehrer und wölfe, so heimlich neben einschleichen und listiglich betrigen wöllen, eingefiiret werden

Ye have heard, my beloved in the Lord, that beside the bishops elders also are set by the Holy Ghost for the government of the church of God. Therefore it will behove you that ye take especial great care and be diligent how the church may be well ruled, and that ye be furthersome in all things to the other ministers which labour in the word with faithful counsel and help, even as valiant and wise councillors also behave themselves toward the burgomaster where a good order is to be set up in the common weal. (1) But above all things ye shall, together with the other ministers of the church, with highest diligence prevent that no falsifying of doctrine be brought in, whether by those which preach publicly in the church, or by false teachers and wolves which secretly creep in beside and will craftily deceive [...]

**Ordination.** After the prayer the pastor and the other ministers lay hands on the elders, "as also before said", using the rite of the ministers' ordination (Sehling 8, p. 209):

> Darnach soll der pfarherr und die andern ministri ihnen die hende auflegen, wie auch zuvor gesagt, etc. (9) Nach dem allen soll man die ordinanden in die mit stellen und ihn die kirch zu versorgen und zu verwalten mit solchen worten befehlen: So befehlen wir euch diese kirch, in welcher ihr zu eltesten seid erwelet worden

Thereafter shall the pastor and the other ministers lay their hands upon them, as is also said before, etc. (9) After all this, the ordinands shall be set in the midst, and the church committed to them to care for and to govern with such words: So we commit unto you this church, in which ye have been chosen to be elders [...]

**Elders at the ordination of ministers.** The traffic also runs the other way. At the ordination of a new minister of the word, the elders lay on hands with the superintendent and the ministers (Sehling 8, p. 205):

> Nach dem gebet soll der superintendens sampt den andern dienern des worts und eltesten den ordinanden die hend auflegen

After the prayer the superintendent, together with the other ministers of the word and elders, shall lay hands upon the ordinands […]

The editor of the Hessian volume notes that Johannes a Lasco (Reformed) also knew an ordination of the governing elders and of the deacons (Sehling 8, p. 208, note 97).

#### 16.6.3 The Reformed orders: four offices, elders who govern with the ministers

**Micron's *Ordinancien*** (London 1554, printed for Norden 1565; Reformed) gives the classic Reformed account. There are two "kinds" (*geschlechte*) of elders. Some labour in word and doctrine, and are called bishops, shepherds and teachers. Others "minister not the public service of the word and sacraments", but are helpers of the ministers. Paul calls these "governments" (1 Corinthians 12:28). One of the elders presides, and the king's charter calls him the superintendent. **Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565** (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, pp. 587–588):

> und die andere eltesten, wiewol sie den offentlichen dienst des worts und der sacramenten nit bedienen, dennoch sind sie gehülfen der ander diener und stehen ihnen bey mit allem ernst, mit rat und hülf, auf daß die gemeine Gottes in aller gottseligkeit, heiligkeit, friede, ordnung und erbarkeit nach dem wort Gottes regieret und erhalten werde; darumb werden sie auch von Paulo regenten genennet. Unter disen zweien geschlechten der eltisten ist einer auß ihrer zale der vornemest, darzu ordentlich erwehlet, auf daß durch seine autoritet ein eintrechtige vergleichung unter allen in allen dingen nach dem wort Gottes gehalten werde. Und dieser ist von k. m. in ihrem privilegio genennet superintendens, das ist aufseher. Die diaken aber tragen sorge für die armen der gemein.

[…] and the other elders, although they minister not the public service of the word and of the sacraments, yet are they helpers of the other ministers, and stand by them with all earnestness, with counsel and help, that the congregation of God may be ruled and preserved in all godliness, holiness, peace, order and honesty according to the word of God; wherefore they are also called by Paul governments. Among these two kinds of elders one out of their number is the chief, orderly chosen thereto, that by his authority an accordant agreement may be held among all in all things according to the word of God. And he is called by the king's majesty in their privilege superintendent, that is, overseer. But the deacons take care for the poor of the congregation.

The elders are confirmed after questions and prayer by **laying on of hands**, "by the other ministers and by the minister of the word" (Reformed; Sehling 7/1, p. 596). The words are nearly those later used in Kurpfalz, given below.

**Kurpfalz** (Reformed). The elders of the Electoral Palatinate were set up by the edict of 1570, after the dispute with Erastus. Sehling's editors describe that dispute in their introduction (Sehling 14, p. 53, editors' introduction):

> Umstritten war nicht die Zuchtübung als solche, sondern die Frage, von wem, in welchen Fällen und in welcher Weise sie zu handhaben sei. Die Befürworter der calvinischen Kirchenzucht standen auf der Linie von Katechismus und Kirchenordnung und unterstrichen das göttliche Recht der Presbyterien, die Notwendigkeit der Abmahnung vom Abendmahl bei Irrlehrern und besserungsunwilligen Sündern durch dieses und im Prinzip die scharfe Trennung einer weltlichen und kirchlichen Strafgewalt.

What was in dispute was not the exercise of discipline as such, but the question by whom, in what cases and in what manner it was to be handled. The advocates of the Calvinist church discipline stood on the line of the Catechism and the church order, and underlined the divine right of the presbyteries, the necessity of exclusion from the supper of false teachers and of sinners unwilling to amend, by this [presbytery], and in principle the sharp separation of a temporal and an ecclesiastical power of punishment.

The decision fell in 1569, with opinions by Beza, Ursinus and Zanchi against Erastus. On 13 July 1570 the edict set up church discipline and the classical assemblies. The editors add that Erastus still won concessions, including the involvement of the magistrate in excommunication (same page).

Under Frederick IV a new form for installing the elders was issued, dated 9 December 1592; the editors say the new elders were installed at the end of the New Year's service. Its title is "Form, how the elders which labour not in the word are confirmed in the

congregation". The elders are questioned:

- whether they feel the witness of the Spirit;
- whether Scripture contains all that is needful to salvation;
- whether they will assist the ministers and accept correction themselves.

The congregation prays, and then hands are laid on them. **Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, pp. 789–790):

> Form, wie man die eltesten, so in dem wort nit arbeyten, in der gemein bestediget etc. […] Darnach werden ihnen die händt aufgelegt von den andern dihnern und vom diener des worts, welcher spricht mit heller stim also: Gott und unser himlischer vater, der euch mit uns zu dem regiment diser seiner gemeindt (nach der lehr seines worts) berufen und ausgesondert hat, der erleuchte euch auch durch seinen heiligen geist und stercke euch mit der kraft seiner unuberwindtlicher handt, das ihr euern dihnst treulich und bestendig volnfuhren moget zu ehren seines namens und erbauung seiner gemeindt, Amen. […] Zum letzten wendet er seine red zu den angenommenen eltesten und vermahnet sie, das sie keine acht haben sollen auf die verachtung undt haß der welt, keine person ansehen, sondern das sie einen jeden ohne ansehen der person vermahnen, bessern und strafen nach dem prauch der christlichen strafe, das sie auch uf die lehr, sitten, ja auf das gantze leben aller diner des worts ernstlich acht haben, die wölf vor der herdt der gemeyne mit den dihnern des worts wehren

Form, how the elders which labour not in the word are confirmed in the congregation, etc. […] Thereafter hands are laid upon them by the other ministers and by the minister of the word, who speaketh with a clear voice thus: God and our heavenly Father, which hath called and separated you with us to the government of this his congregation (according to the doctrine of his word), enlighten you also by his Holy Spirit and strengthen you with the power of his invincible hand, that ye may fulfil your service faithfully and constantly, to the honour of his name and the edifying of his congregation. Amen. […] Lastly he turneth his speech to the elders received, and admonisheth them that they regard not the contempt and hatred of the world, respect no person, but that they admonish, amend and rebuke every one without respect of person according to the use of christian rebuke; that they also take earnest heed to the doctrine, manners, yea, to the whole life of all ministers of the word; [and] ward off the wolves from the flock of the congregation together with the ministers of the word […]

The editors of the volume stress the point: "it is especially noteworthy that they are **ordained by laying on of hands** by the minister of the church and the individual elders continuing in office" (Sehling 19/2, p. 695, editors' introduction). The same form was adopted in Ysenburg-Ronneburg in 1592 (Reformed) (Sehling 10, p. 601).

**Kurpfalz about 1601** (Reformed). The Palatine *Presbyterordnung* of about 1601 defines the presbytery as "certain persons chosen yearly" beside the ministers, "as elders and overseers", to deal with offences in doctrine and life. Their sanctions:

- admonition, once, twice and three times;
- for the obstinate, being "quietly" warned off the sacraments.

The order grounds the office on Christ's own institution in Matthew 18. **Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 595):

> daß durchs presbyterium oder eltistenrhat dieses und anders nicht verstanden werde, dan das neben den kirchendienern jedes orts etliche gewiße personen zue eltisten und aufsehern der christlichen gemein jerlich erwehlet werden, welche anstatt der gantzen gemein zue gewißen zeiten, nachdeme es die not erfordert, zusammenkommen und, was sich in lehr und leben für ärgernus in der gemain zuetragen, sich dieselben zue verbeßern und abzueschaffen miteinander underreden, auch vermanungen aus dem wort Gottes nach der ordnung des herren Christi zum ersten, andern und dritten mahl […] thun und, da einer in offenen sunden und ergernus mutwillig verharren wolt, denselben von den hailigen sacramenten in der still mit christlicher beschaidenhait abmahnen, biß er beßerung verhaiset und erzeiget. Daß nun diese ordnung in Gottes wort gegrundet und Christus selbst solche angeordnet und befolhen habe, weisen nachfolgende spruch der heiligen schrift clarlich aus.

[…] that by the presbytery or council of elders nothing else is to be understood than this: that beside the ministers of the church in every place certain particular persons are chosen yearly to be elders and overseers of the christian congregation, which in the stead of the whole congregation come together at certain times, as need requireth, and confer together how the offences which arise in doctrine and life in the congregation may be amended and done away; and also make admonitions out of the word of

God, according to the order of the Lord Christ, the first, second and third time [...] and, if one would wilfully continue in open sins and offence, warn him off from the holy sacraments quietly, with christian discretion, until he promise and shew amendment. Now that this order is grounded in God's word, and that Christ himself hath ordained and commanded it, the following sayings of holy scripture clearly shew.

These elders take a handfast vow (*angeloben*) to the published order. They are "confirmed" and announced from the pulpit on New Year's Day, then "confirmed through the common christian prayer". There is no laying on of hands. **Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 598):

> angeloben laßen und sie also confirmirn und mit pflichten annehmen sollt. Nochmals sollen sie der gemeine auf den neuen jarstag von der cantzel verkündet und durch das christliche, gemaine gebet bestetiget werden mit fleißiger ermahnung, daß sie jederman für ordentliche eltisten und vorsteher der gemein erkennen, in gebürlichen ehren halten und ihnen gehorsam leisten sollen.

[...] thou shalt cause them to vow by handfast, and so confirm them and receive them under obligation. Afterward they shall be proclaimed to the congregation from the pulpit on New Year's day, and confirmed through the christian common prayer, with diligent admonition that every man acknowledge them for orderly elders and governors of the congregation, hold them in due honour, and render them obedience.

**Hanau-Münzenberg (1609)** (Reformed) copies this procedure. It adds that the minister must teach the congregation "that the office of elders is of God". This is said partly to comfort the elders, partly so that the people will not "exempt themselves" from their rebukes. **Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, 1609** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 508):

> in handgelübdnus genommen werden. Darauf fürters folgenden sontag nach einer kurzen predigt die eltesten der gemeinde wider sollen verkündiget und also nach beschehener fleißiger ermahnung, daß sie jederman fur ordentliche eltesten und vorsteher der gemein erkennen, in gebürlichen ehren halten und ihnen gehorsamb leisten sollen, durch das christliche gemeine gebet bestettiget werden. Es ist aber bei solcher ankündigung und bestettigung von nöten, daß der kirchendiener der gemeinde aus dem wort Gottes deutlich anzeige, 1. daß der eltesten ampt von Gott seie aus obgesetzten zeugnußen der heiligen schrift, den eltesten zum besten, damit sie solch ampt als einen gottlichen beruf uf sich nehmen [...] darnach der gemeinde wegen, daß sie solchem ampt sich nicht widersetzen noch davon eximiren

[...] shall be taken under handfast vow. Whereupon on the following Sunday after a short sermon the elders shall be proclaimed again to the congregation, and so, after diligent admonition made that every man acknowledge them for orderly elders and governors of the congregation, hold them in due honour and render them obedience, be confirmed through the christian common prayer. But at such proclamation and confirmation it is needful that the minister of the church shew the congregation plainly out of the word of God, 1. that the office of elders is of God, from the testimonies of holy scripture set down above: for the elders' good, that they may take such office upon them as a divine calling [...]; next, for the congregation's sake, that they set not themselves against such office nor exempt themselves from it [...]

**Pfalz-Veldenz (1574)** calls its elders "censors". They are presented to the assembled congregation, "commended" from the pulpit with prayer and "set into this high office", "as we see that the apostles ordained the Elders and commended them to the congregation, Acts 14; likewise also the Deacons, Acts 6". **Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574, "Ordnung der Eltisten"** (Sehling 18, p. 573):

> Wölche zu disem hohen ampt erwöhlet sein, die sollen darnach uff einen gewissen tag, wann die gemein beyeinander versamlet (wölche auch vermahnet soll werden, fleissig zuerscheinen und Gott anzurueffen), berueffen und der gemein fürgestelt, also offentlich mit dem gebett von der Cantzel durch den Pfarrer der gantzen Gemein commendirt und inn diß hohe ampt eingesetzt werden [...] wie wir dann sehen, das die apostel die Eltisten geordinirt und der gemein befolhen, Actor. 14. Dessgleichen auch die Diacon, Actor. 6.

Those which are chosen to this high office shall thereafter, upon a set day when the congregation is assembled together (which also shall be admonished to appear diligently and to call upon God), be called and set before the congregation, and so publicly with prayer from the pulpit by the Pastor be commended to the whole Congregation and set into this high office [...] even as we see that the apostles ordained the Elders and commended them to the congregation, Acts 14; likewise also the Deacons, Acts 6.

**Solms (1594)** (Reformed), in the discipline order of Count Johann Albrecht of Solms-Braunfels, binds its elders by an **oath**, "so help us God and his only Son", to watch over all offence and idolatry. They are to admonish offenders and, if admonition fails,

report them to the proper authority. **Solms, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1594, "Eyd der eltesten"** (Reformed; Sehling 9, p. 338):

> Wir schweren und geloben, daß nach ausweisung unsers hohen ampts wir fleißig uffsicht haben wollen uff alles ergerlich wesen in der kirchen, alle abgötterei, gotteslesterung, leichtfertigkeit und anderß, so wieder die ehre Gottes und daß h. evangelium streittet, das wir dieselbige, so viel uns möglich, verhindern und die ubertretter, wie immer die gelegenheit sein mag, zu einem bessern leben ermahnen wollen, da aber solch ermahnung nicht fruchten wolte, daß ohne neidt, haß, freundschafft, feindschafft solch unbußfertig wesen wir an geburende ort gelangen und von dannen hulf, rath und beistand erwarten wollen [...] so wahr uns Gott helf und sein einiger sohn.

We swear and vow that, according to the tenor of our high office, we will have diligent oversight upon all offensive dealing in the church, all idolatry, blasphemy, levity and other things which strive against the honour of God and the holy gospel; that we will hinder the same so far as is possible for us, and admonish the transgressors, howsoever the occasion may be, to a better life; but if such admonition will not profit, that without envy, hatred, friendship [or] enmity we will bring such impenitent dealing to the proper place, and from thence await help, counsel and support [...] so help us God and his only Son.

Similar sworn **censors** are found in the **Wild- and Rhinegraviate** (1603). They are chosen by the pastor and the old censors and confirmed "under oath" by the superintendent and officials (Sehling 19/2, p. 600).

**Nassau-Dillenburg (1582)** (Reformed) counts the seniors as the third of the four offices. They are elected by the presbytery and confirmed by the classis (§16.5.3).

#### 16.6.4 The Bohemian Brethren: lay presbyters and *presbyterae*

The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) have lay *presbyteri politici*. These are "political presbyters" or "censors of manners", who oversee the life of the congregation and sit in a place of honour in church. The men of the congregation elect them by free vote after a visitor's admonition. They bind themselves "by voice and by hand given" to the bishops, the pastor and the church. The same is done for the **women elders** (*presbyterae*), with only women present. There is **no laying on of hands**. **Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576, "Presbyterorum politicorum ordinatio"** (Bohemian Brethren; Sehling 4, p. 289):

> Presbyterorum ordinatio, quum opus est, hoc ritu peragitur. Iubentur ante concionem vespertinam mature se sistere omnes viri, ibique praemissa a visitatoribus admonitione, eligunt liberis votis quos munere illo dignos existimant. Pluribus itaque votis designati, vespertina concione finita a visitatore evocantur, illisque officia muneris huius (toto auscultante coetu) praeleguntur; illi vero voce et stipulata manu antistitibus unitatis, pastori, ecclesiaeque suae, fidem et diligentiam obstringunt. Atque ut in templo quoque inspectorum munere fungi possint, peculiari etiam sessionis loco (ad commodiorem populi intuitum) cohonestantur. Similiter proceditur cum eliguntur presbyterae; excepto, quod solo foemineo sexu praesente res peragitur.

The ordination of presbyters, when there is need, is performed with this rite. All the men are bidden to present themselves early before the evening sermon; and there, an admonition having first been given by the visitors, they choose by free votes those whom they judge worthy of that office. Those therefore which are designated by the most votes are called forth by the visitor when the evening sermon is ended, and the duties of this office are read to them (the whole assembly hearkening); and they bind their faith and diligence by voice and by hand given to the bishops of the unity, to the pastor, and to their church. And that they may also discharge the office of overseers in the church, they are honoured with a peculiar place of sitting (for the more convenient view of the people). The like is done when presbyteresses are chosen, except that the matter is performed with the female sex alone present.

Like the acolytes (§16.3.4), these presbyters are said to be "ordained", but by a handfast vow alone. This sets them clearly apart from the deacons and ministers, on whom hands are laid (§16.5.3).

#### 16.6.5 The Lutheran orders: churchwardens and clerical seniors

**Churchwardens.** In the Lutheran orders the lay officers of the parish are the churchwardens, called *Kirchenväter*, *Kirchgeschworene*, *Kastenherren* or *Kirchenpfleger*. They administer church goods, buildings and alms, often with the council. They are not given spiritual jurisdiction. Memmingen's discipline order (1532, Moderate Reformed) does give its *Kirchenpfleger* a wide advisory role over worship, schools, alms and the ban. But it expressly denies them any temporal jurisdiction, "so that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city". **Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 12, p. 248):

> Dann wir solchen kirchenpflegern thain zeitlich jurisdiction in unser stat geben noch furter zu geben gedenken, auf daz nit abermals zwo zeitlich oberkaiten in unser statt aufkomen

For we give such churchwardens no temporal jurisdiction in our city, neither think to give [any] hereafter, to the end that two temporal authorities arise not again in our city […]

Dinkelsbühl's twelve *Kirchenpfleger* fill their own vacancies "together with the pastor, who shall bring the Bible or the church order with him" (*Kirchenpflegeordnung*, 1574; Sehling 12, p. 131). In Augsburg the *Vergleichsartikel* of 1591 provide six *Kirchenpfleger* of the Augsburg Confession: three appointed by the council and three chosen by the evangelical citizens. They take part in the examination of new ministers (Sehling 12, pp. 109–110). The orders give no rite of installation for any of these wardens.

**Clerical seniors.** Where Lutheran orders speak of *seniores*, they usually mean **senior clergy**:

- In Brandenburg-Ansbach each dean, with the counsel of the whole chapter, chooses "two seniors, the fittest among all his subordinates", as assessors and definitors. They administer the superintendency in a vacancy and join him in visitation (*Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78; Sehling 11, pp. 347, 350).
- Pomerania and the Silesian duchies (Liegnitz) use *seniores* in the same sense. The Pomeranian synod of 1574 bids the younger ministers honour the *seniores*, and has the superintendent punish unruly ministers with the counsel of the provosts and seniors (Sehling 4, p. 489).

**"Elders" meaning the pastors.** The ordination rite of the Erbach church order (1560) reads Titus 1:5 of the pastors themselves. Christ commanded his apostles "to choose and set elders in all his congregations, which shall preach his gospel pure and unfalsified, dispense the most worthy sacraments, and diligently provide and perform all cure of souls and shepherd's service". **Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560, ordination rite** (Sehling 9, p. 446):

> auch den Seinigen durch seine Apostel befohlen, bey allen seinen Gemeinen Eltesten zu erwehlen und zu setzen, die sein Evangelion Rein und unverfälscht predigen, die Hochwürdige Sacramenta dispensiren und alle Seelsorg und Hirtendienst fleissig versehen und verrichten sollen.

[…] and also commanded his own through his Apostles to choose and set Elders in all his congregations, which shall preach his Gospel pure and unfalsified, dispense the most worthy Sacraments, and diligently provide and perform all cure of souls and shepherd's service.

**No ruling elders in the Lutheran orders.** In short, a Lutheran order that speaks of "elders" is speaking of the pastors, of the senior pastors, or of the churchwardens. The **ruling elder** with a share in the power of the keys belongs to the Bucerian and Hessian (Moderate Reformed) and the Reformed orders.

The oaths of churchwardens and stewards are treated in Chapter 13, §13.12.4.

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## 16.7 Sacristans, altar care, deaconesses and the religious life

This section treats six groups that stood beside the clergy without being clergy:

- the **sacristan**, who kept the vessels, vestments and font (§16.7.1);
- the people who cared for the **altar**, the nearest thing in the corpus to an altar guild (§16.7.2);
- **deaconesses** and the women who served the sick (§16.7.3);
- **monks** (§16.7.4) and **nuns** (§16.7.5);
- **beguines**, **tertiaries**, the **Brethren of the Common Life** and the lay **confraternities** (§16.7.6).

How each of them was received or installed is set out with the full forms in Chapter 13 §§13.12.2 and 13.12.6–13.12.10, and summarised in the table of §16.8 below.

### 16.7.1 Sacristans

**No separate office.** No evangelical order has a sacristan distinct from the sexton. The medieval sacristan (*sacrista*, *custos*, *Sigrist*, *Mesner*) and the bell-ringer, sweeper and doorkeeper were one lay servant, called *Küster*, *Custos*, *Kirchner*, *Glöckner*,

*Opfermann*, *Mesner* or *Sigrist* according to region. The porter's keys passed to him (§16.3.5). So did the sacristan's charge: the chalices, the vestments and linen, the font and its water, the bread and wine, and the lights. In most villages he was also the schoolmaster.

**Anhalt 1594: the sacristan's duties** (Philippist). The appointment of the sexton of Törten in Anhalt is printed by Sehling as a "sexton's ordinance". It lists the sacristan's work with the rest: ringing, singing, opening and shutting the church, sweeping, "preparing the altar and font", and "vesting and unvesting the pastor". The post was granted for one year at a time. **Anhalt, *Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten*, 8 November 1594** (Philippist; Sehling 2, pp. 579–580):

> Der custos sol nicht allein in gemein alles, was ihme mit leuten, singen, kirchuf und zuschliessen, kehren, altar und taufstein bereiten, an und auskleidung des pfarners, nichts ausgenommen, zustendig und gehorig, hochstes und treues vleisses vorrichten, sondern auch insonderheit alle tage in der wochen, wie in schulen breuchlich, vor und nachmittage idesmals zwo stunden […] vor knaben und megdlein (die ernte ausgenommen) schule halten […] alles bei vorlust des dienstes, welcher dan einem jeden custodi nur ein jahr lang sol zugesagt werden, und er schuldig sein, kurz vor michaelis bei dem pfarner von neuen darumb zu werben.

The sexton shall not only perform in general, with highest and faithful diligence, all that pertaineth and belongeth to him in ringing, singing, opening and shutting the church, sweeping, preparing the altar and font, [and] vesting and unvesting the pastor, nothing excepted; but also in particular every day in the week, as is customary in schools, before and after noon, two hours each time […] keep school for boys and maidens (the harvest excepted) […] all on pain of losing the service, which shall be promised to every sexton for one year only; and he shall be bound, shortly before Michaelmas, to sue anew for it with the pastor.

**The keeper of the vessels.** Because the vessels and vestments were in his keeping, the sexton had to be of known honesty or give surety. **Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590** (Sehling 19/1, p. 438):

> Weil auch den Glöcknern die Kelch, Kirchen Ornat und anders, so in der Kirchen verwahret werden soll, vertrauwet, soll keiner zum Glöckner angenommen werden, er sey dann wol bekandt oder habe einen Vorstandt oder Bürgen, damit, wann etwas durch seinen Unfleiß oder Untreuw der Kirchen entwendet, die Kirch sich deß erlittenen Schadens widerumb bey im zuerholen habe.

Forasmuch also as the chalices, the church's ornaments and other things which are to be kept in the church are entrusted to the bell-ringers, none shall be received as bell-ringer unless he be well known or have a warrantor or surety; that if anything be taken away from the church through his negligence or unfaithfulness, the church may recover the loss suffered again from him.

The Heidelberg bell-ringer of 1572 (Reformed) likewise received "the cloths, silver and vessels for the Supper and baptism" by inventory (Chapter 13 §13.12.2).

**At the altar and the font.** The sacristan's liturgical tasks recur across the orders:

- **The sick.** In Hohenlohe the pastor called to the sick takes "with him, together with his sexton, the particles, chalice, corporal, surplice" (Sehling 15, p. 73). Württemberg's German-school order of 1559 bids schoolmasters who also held the *Meßnerei* go with the pastor to the sick "and carry the chalice" (Sehling 17/1, p. 585).
- **The font.** The Lippe sexton was to "fill the font often with clean, fresh water" (Sehling 21, p. 447). Baden in 1601 told the *Sigristen* to bring fresh water, "yet not too cold", and not to let it stand for weeks in the font (Sehling 16, p. 551).
- **Bread and wine.** Veit Dietrich forbade pastors to set hosts and wine on the altar without measure and leave the rest "to the sexton for his use at home" (Sehling 11, p. 531). In the Schönburg lordships in 1542 the sexton was no longer to buy the communion wine with his own money; the church was to pay and he to fetch it (Sehling 2, p. 176).

**Not women.** At Heilbronn in 1543 the council reserved the sacristan's office at the font to the sexton, and forbade it to women and maids, lest "the holy act of baptism be mocked by wicked people". **Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 17/1, p. 315):

> Darzu will ein Er. w. für. Rath haben, das die Mesner unnd nicht Fraw oder Medlen den Tauff zuund aufthuendt oder dem pfarrherrn, seinen diacon, die handtzweel, zu trocknen die hend, reichent, sonder er soll es selbs thon, damit der heilig actus des tauffs von bösen leuten nicht verlacht werdte.

Moreover an honourable, wise [and] provident council will have it that the sextons, and not women or maids, open and shut the font, or reach the towel to the pastor [and] his deacon to dry the hands; but he shall do it himself, that the holy act of baptism be not mocked by wicked people.

**The old abuses.** The sacristan's access to the font water and the hosts made him suspect of the old "sorcery". Electoral Saxony in 1580, copied by Brandenburg-Ansbach in 1594 (Sehling 11, p. 391), ordered the pastors to stop it. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 426):

> Nach dem an etlichen orten noch von der papistischen zauberei geblieben, das die glöckner das ubergeblieben taufwasser verkaufen, wie auch etliche mit den ubergebliebenen hostien handlen, welche nachmals zu zauberei gebraucht, sollen die pfarrer die glöckner deshalben ernstlich vermanen, das sie es abschaffen, und da es nachmals wieder geschehe, hertiglich gestraft werden sol.

Forasmuch as in some places there yet remaineth of the papistical sorcery, that the bell-ringers sell the baptismal water left over, as also some deal in the hosts left over, which are afterward used for sorcery, the pastors shall earnestly admonish the bell-ringers thereof, that they put it away; and if it happen again afterward, it shall be sharply punished.

**Appointment.** The sacristan was appointed, not ordained. In Strasbourg (1531, Moderate Reformed) the vacant offices of "helpers or *Sigristen*" were filled "by the pastors and parish churchwardens, and not otherwise" (Sehling 20/1, p. 226). Elsewhere the council, the patron or the pastor with the parish chose him, and he bound himself by pledge, oath or written *Revers* (§16.8).

**In the convents.** The one sacristan with a distinct title is a woman: the **custorin** among the "spiritual or church offices" of the evangelical convent of Keppel (§16.7.5).

### 16.7.2 Altar care: no altar guild

**No guild.** The corpus knows no altar guild: no society of women or laymen charged with washing the altar linen, baking the hosts or adorning the altar. The care of the altar fell to three others:

- the **sexton** or sacristan (§16.7.1);
- the **lay churchwardens**, deacons of the chest or *Altarleute*, who bought the bread, wine and candles and kept the church's ornaments;
- in the convents, the sisters who held the church offices (§16.7.5).

**The deacons of the church keep the altar.** The Pomeranian synodal statutes of 1574 charge the lay *diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* (§16.5.2) with the altar and its ornaments. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 491):

> Vigilent etiam pastores, ne structuram ecclesiae diaconi negligant, sed in templis aram, cum ornatu suo, suggestum, baptisterium, sedilia, et omnia honeste et decenter conservent, et coemiteria honeste muniri curent.

Let the pastors also watch that the deacons neglect not the fabric of the church, but that in the churches they keep the altar with its ornament, the pulpit, the font, the seats, and all things honestly and decently, and take care that the churchyards be honestly fenced.

In Pfalz-Neuburg it was the churchwardens who received a florin "for the buying of hosts and wine" (Sehling 13, p. 208).

**The confraternities dissolved.** Before the Reformation the lights and adornment of many altars were kept by lay confraternities. These were dissolved, and their goods went to the common chest. The first such order, Leisnig's, names the brotherhoods of the Kaland, of St Anne and of the shoemakers' journeymen. **Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523** (Sehling 1, p. 599):

> Was an barem gelde, zinskaufen, cleinoden silberwerk, vorrathe und farende habe, zu den berumbten bruderschaften, des kalands, Sanct Annen, und der schuknechte, bis anher eingesamlet, und den selbigen zustendig ist, mit den brivlichen urkunden, verzeichnussen und registern, allenthalben in diesen gemeinen kasten geschlagen und verordent, dabei zubleiben.

Whatsoever in ready money, bought rents, jewels, silver plate, stores and movable goods hath been gathered hitherto for the said brotherhoods, of the Kaland, of St Anne and of the shoemakers' journeymen, and belongeth to the same, together with the

deeds, inventories and registers, is altogether cast into and ordained for this common chest, there to remain.

**Women at the altar.** No order gives women a role at the altar. Heilbronn forbade them even to open the font or hand the towel (§16.7.1).

### 16.7.3 Deaconesses, sick-women and *Seelfrauen*

**The word.** The word *diaconissa* occurs once in an order of the corpus, at Keppel in 1570, for the sister "who distributeth the alms" (§16.7.5). There is no order of deaconesses and no rite for them. But three kinds of women did work that the early Church had given to deaconesses and widows:

- the **convent almoner** at Keppel;
- the **women elders** (*presbyterae*) of the Bohemian Brethren (Hussite), elected by the women of the congregation and bound by handfast vow (§16.6.4);
- the **sick-women** (*Seelfrauen*, *Krankenwärterinnen*), appointed by the council or the pastor to nurse and comfort the sick and dying. Some had been beguines.

**Keppel 1570: the deaconess as almoner. Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570** (Sehling 10, p. 141):

> Geystliche oder kirchenambter seindt: Leßmeisterin oder priorin, vorsengerin, diaconissa, das ist, die almusenn außtheylett, […] catecheten, […] custorin. Weltliche ampter seind: Kellerin, kirchenmeisterin, kuchenmeisterin, speichermeisterinn, die der scheiben wartet, die die kinder nehen, stickhen unnd wirckhen lernen […]

The spiritual or church offices are: the lecturess or prioress; the precentress; the deaconess, that is, she who distributeth the alms; […] the catechists; […] the sacristaness. The temporal offices are: the cellaress, the church-mistress, the kitchen-mistress, the granary-mistress, she that keepeth the plate, [and] they that teach the children to sew, embroider and weave […]

**The *Seelfrauen*.** In the Franconian and Bavarian towns the *Seelfrauen* were the inmates of the *Seelhäuser*, foundations for poor widows and single women who nursed the sick and prayed for the dying (Sehling 11, p. 320, editors' note). The orders kept them, but under the pastor and the word:

- **Brandenburg-Ansbach 1536.** The visitors asked for oversight "of the *Seelfrau* and other such women who may serve the sick", that they serve for a reasonable wage (Sehling 11, p. 320).
- **Regensburg 1543.** The order appointed *Seelfrauen*, and men also, to attend the sick and dying, and prescribed what they were to say. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543** (Sehling 13, p. 410):

> Das sünst verordnet werden seelfrauen, auch manspersonen, die zu den kranken, wu man ir begert, sich gebrauchen lassen und der sterbenden warten. Und solche sollen ein christlichen verstand haben, das sie die sterbenden allein auf das verdinst Christi weisen, nicht auf eigen verdinst oder fürpitt der heiligen, inen das vaterunser und den glauben fürsprechen und, wus zeit hat, gegründete psalm und geseng, als: Aus tiefer not schrei ich zu dir etc., In fried und freud ich far dahin, Nun freut euch, lieben christen gemein, von der tauf, vom sacrament des leibs und bluts etc., nicht alte, irrige gebet und spruch.

That besides there be appointed *Seelfrauen*, and men also, who shall let themselves be used for the sick where they are desired, and attend upon the dying. And such shall have a christian understanding, that they point the dying to the merit of Christ alone, not to their own merit or the intercession of the saints; [that they] say the Lord's Prayer and the Creed before them, and, where there is time, well-grounded psalms and songs, as: *Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir*, etc., *In Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin*, *Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein*, [the hymns] of baptism [and] of the sacrament of the body and blood, etc.; not old, erroneous prayers and sayings.

- **Nördlingen 1544.** Kaspar Löner asked that the women whom the council had appointed to tend the sick be sent to him, so that he might examine their faith and understanding and teach them what they did not know (Sehling 12, p. 315). Sehling's editors note that this had been the task of the *Seelnonnen* of the town's beguine house, closed in 1536.
- **Wolfstein 1574.** Women who served the sick were to visit them often (Sehling 13, p. 582); the editors compare the Nuremberg *Seelfrauen*.

**Beguines turned sick-visitors.** Heilbronn in 1531 gathered its beguines into one house and charged them, as their service, to visit the sick and instruct them by God's word (§16.7.6).

**Hospital nurses.** The later Reformed orders put the sick-nurse under the hospital master. The Heidelberg hospital order of 1594 (Reformed) lets the hospital master engage "fit sick-nurses" (*kranckenwärterin*) and dismiss them for misconduct, with the advice of the inspectors, preacher, physician and surgeon (Sehling 19/2, p. 827). Here the office is a domestic service, without any churchly character.

#### 16.7.4 Monks

**Profession ended.** Every evangelical territory ended new professions. The monks were offered three choices:

- to leave, marry or take up a trade, with their goods or a pension;
- to stay for life in a house set apart for them, with maintenance;
- in a few great abbeys, to live under an evangelical rule as teachers and students for the ministry.

**Württemberg 1535.** The first Württemberg monastery order forbade all new admissions, to the monasteries and to the houses of beguines and Lollards alike, and sent the unprofessed novices home. **Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535** (Sehling 16, p. 79):

> Fürohin söllen ouch kaine personen in die Clöster auffgenomen werden, desgleichen ouch in die beginen- und Nollhart haußer. Wa ouch jetzund novitzien, die noch nit profession gethon, vorhanden weren, söllen mit zimlicher zerung iren eltern oder frainden unverzogenlich haimgeschickt werden.

Henceforth also no persons shall be received into the cloisters, nor likewise into the houses of the beguines and Lollards. And where there be now novices which have not yet made profession, they shall be sent home to their parents or kinsfolk without delay, with reasonable provision for the way.

Those who left received back what they had brought in, or forty florins a year for life. The few remaining mendicant friars were gathered into one house, the old and weak to be cared for "that they may so die in peace" (Sehling 16, pp. 79–80). In 1552 Duke Christoph forbade the abbots to "entangle" boys with "superstitious ceremonies and vows" to remain in the cloister (Sehling 16, p. 199).

**Esslingen 1535: the friars who stayed** (Moderate Reformed). Esslingen's order for the remaining Franciscans let any friar marry with a settlement from the council. Those who stayed received board and a yearly allowance. **Esslingen, *Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster*, 6 September 1535** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 17/2, p. 382):

> Welcher under den ordenspersonen sich in ain ander erbar, christenlich wesen schicken und sich in den ehelichen stannd wurde begeben, des ainem jeden nach Gottes lob und seiner seelen hail anzerichten erlaubt sein soll, derselbig soll durch ainen ersamen rath als die obrigkait nach einkomen ains jeden klosters mit zimblicher leibsunderhaltung, wie es ainem ersamen rath gefellig, außgesteurt und versorgt werden. Und welche ordenspersonen nit herausser khomen, besonder also im kloster zuverharren gedechten, dieselbigen sollen mit zimblicher leibsnarung versorgt und demselbigen, so er ain priester gewesen, zehen guldin unnd ainem layen bruder funff guldin alle jar fur klaidung und anndere leibs notturfft gegeben werden.

Whosoever among the persons of the order would betake himself to another honest, christian estate and enter into the estate of matrimony, which shall be permitted to every one to undertake to the praise of God and the health of his soul, the same shall be set out and provided for by an honourable council, as the magistrate, according to the revenue of each cloister, with reasonable maintenance, as it shall please an honourable council. And those persons of the order which come not out, but purpose so to remain in the cloister, shall be provided with reasonable sustenance; and to him that hath been a priest ten florins, and to a lay brother five florins, shall be given every year for clothing and other bodily necessity.

**Evangelical monasteries.** Where the princes kept the great abbeys, they kept them as schools for the ministry. Their "conventuals" and "novices" were students under an evangelical abbot:

- **Württemberg.** At Herrenalb in 1556 the first Lutheran abbot agreed statutes by which "the conventuals and novices" were to pray morning and evening a Latin prayer for the church, the emperor, the duke and the abbot, and to live under discipline and study (Sehling 16, p. 317). The installation of the Württemberg prelates is in Chapter 13 §13.11.3.
- **Pfalz-Simmern.** At the Augustinian house of Ravengiersburg in 1560 no novice or prebendary was to be received without the duke's and the prior's knowledge. The young men were to be trained for the preaching office, and the

convent might sing in Latin. **Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560** (Sehling 19/2, p. 658):

> Further soll auch kein Junger oder Prebender on unser, Hertzog Georg als Landtßfürsten, auch mein, des Paters, wissen und willen angenommen werden, und soln solige junge herrn und schuler, so jetzundt albereit im Closter oder konfftiglich mit unserm wissen, wie obgemelt, angenommen, dahin mit Ernst geleret, gewiesen und gehalten werden, das sie konfftiglichen in unserm Fürstenthumb das PredigAmt oder sunst ein ander ehrlig Kirchendienst, darzu sie duchtig erkhannt, verwessen und verwalten mugen

Further also no youth or prebendary shall be received without the knowledge and will of us, Duke George, as prince of the land, and of me, the Father [prior]; and such young lords and scholars as are now already in the cloister, or shall hereafter be received with our knowledge as aforesaid, shall be taught, directed and held earnestly to this end, that they may hereafter in our principality hold and administer the preaching office or some other honourable church service for which they are found apt.

**No vows.** None of these houses required a vow. Ravengiersburg's scholar who was sent to the university bound himself only to serve the duke and the house (Sehling 19/2, p. 658).

#### 16.7.5 Nuns

**The women's houses survived longest.** Many nunneries, above all the noble foundations of the north, survived the Reformation as evangelical convents or *Stifte*. They became homes and schools for unmarried women, keeping a rule, a habit of sorts, the hours in German or Latin, and an elected head (abbess, prioress or *domina*). The orders reformed them on four points:

- **Admission.** No one was to be clothed without the prince's or council's consent. At Goslar's convent of Frankenberg (1542) and in Württemberg no one was to be admitted at all.
- **Vows.** The vows of perpetual chastity and the cloister were not binding. A sister might leave and marry with her goods.
- **Habit.** The consecrated habit (cowl, scapular, veil and crown) was abolished or made optional. Baptism was declared the true clothing.
- **Worship.** The hours and the Mass were reformed. Daily preaching, the catechism and schooling for girls were added.

**Goslar 1542: no new nuns, free to marry. Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg*, 1542** (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 275):

> 5. Nullas imposterum personas ad habitum sui ordinis admittent, eas vero, quae nondum professionem emiserint, cum omnibus, quae coenobio contulerunt, ab se dimittent. 6. Unicuique conventus personae liberum licitumque erit vel in coenobio toto tempore vitae permanere vel cum honesto aliquo matrimonium inire.

5. They shall admit no persons hereafter to the habit of their order; but those which have not yet made profession they shall send away from them, with all that they brought to the convent. 6. It shall be free and lawful to every person of the convent either to remain in the convent all the time of her life, or to enter into matrimony with some honest man.

**Lüneburg 1574: clothing kept, the habit changed.** The Lüneburg houses still received girls, but under the duke's control. The cowl, scapular, veil and crown were replaced by a plain black or white gown. **Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke William the Younger, 1574** (Sehling 6/1, p. 622):

> So soll auch kein kind und jungfrau eingekleidet werden ohne unsern vorwissen und befelch. Und weil die kappen und schepler und weichel und kreuz auf dem haupt, wie sie die klosterpersonen itz dragen, vielen frommen Christen ergernuß geben […] so sollen furder keine jungfrau in kappen und mit wichel und kreuz bekleidet werden, sonder sie sollen ehrliche schwarze oder weisse rocke von einerlei art und wande und auf dem haupt weisse tucher, wie sie itz haben, ohne seitenburten oder gewirkten hauben tragen, aber keine weichel oder kreuz. […] Es soll auch keine klosterperson in kappen, schefflern, weicheln etc., sondern wie andere Christen in leinenlaken begraben werden.

So also no child or maiden shall be clothed without our foreknowledge and command. And whereas the cowls and scapulars and veils and the cross upon the head, as the persons of the cloister now wear them, give offence to many godly Christians […] henceforth no maiden shall be clothed in cowl and with veil and cross; but they shall wear honest black or white gowns of one fashion and cloth, and upon the head white kerchiefs, as they now have, without side-bands or wrought hoods, but no veil or cross. […] Also no person of the cloister shall be buried in cowl, scapular, veil, etc., but in a linen sheet like other Christians.

**Mecklenburg 1572: baptism the true clothing.** The Mecklenburg convent order of 1572 rejects the blessing of the habit "with certain little prayers" and holy water, and the "superstitious little books of consecration". **Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572**

(Sehling 5, p. 254):

> Desgleichen abergläubischer irthum ist, dass die closterkleider oder cappen, scheppler und weihler, mit gewissen gebetlein eingeweihet und mit weiwasser besprenget, geistlich und herlichere kleider sein, als andere, dadurch sie ihre sünde vor gottes angesicht bedecken und für des teufels anlauf als mit einem harnisch bewahret, Christum anziehen und Christi braut und königinnen werden. Da doch alle christen zugleich in der taufe in einerlei geistlich kleid eingekleidet, den herrn Jesum Christum anziehen

Likewise it is a superstitious error that the cloister garments, or cowls, scapulars and veils, consecrated with certain little prayers and sprinkled with holy water, should be spiritual and more glorious garments than others, whereby they cover their sins before the face of God and are preserved against the assault of the devil as with a harness, put on Christ, and become Christ's bride and queens; whereas all Christians alike are clothed in baptism in one spiritual garment, [and] put on the Lord Jesus Christ […]

On vows the same order teaches that "there is no higher vow than that which we have made in holy baptism", and that vows against God's command are not to be kept (Sehling 5, p. 255). Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel in 1569 argues the same at length. In baptism all Christians are clothed "in a red cowl, which is the most holy rose-coloured blood of our Lord Jesus Christ" and crowned, so that the sister who lays aside her habit and crown loses nothing (Sehling 6/1, pp. 324–326). The form of words for laying it aside is in Chapter 13 §13.12.10.

**Admission by the magistrate.** Strasbourg in 1555 took admission to its remaining women's houses out of the hands of the prioress. The council was to decide, and no girl was to be received under eight years old (Sehling 20/1, p. 454).

**Keppel 1570: an evangelical clothing.** The fullest evangelical form for receiving a nun is the Nassau order for the convent of Keppel. It has the following elements:

- a probation of at least two years;
- questions to the parents, the *domina* and the candidate;
- an oath;
- a sermon;
- the clothing in the sacristy;
- *Veni Sancte Spiritus* and an exhortation at the altar;
- the *Te Deum*.

The exhortation tells the new sister that her vows earn nothing, that the convent is "not a prison" but "as it were a school", and that she may marry in an orderly way. The full rite is in Chapter 13 §13.12.7.

**The offices of the convent.** Keppel divides the sisters' offices into "spiritual or church offices" and "temporal offices" (quoted in §16.7.3):

- *Spiritual.* The lecturess or prioress, the precentress, the deaconess or almoner, the catechists and the sacristaness (*custorin*).
- *Temporal.* The cellaress, the church-mistress (*kirchenmeisterin*), the kitchen-mistress, the granary-mistress, the keeper of the plate and the needlework teachers.

The *domina* assigned these offices. She herself was proposed by the convent from two or three names, confirmed by the count and deposable by him, and swore an oath (Sehling 10, pp. 141–142).

**Abbess and prioress.** In Schleswig-Holstein the abbess of Itzehoe and the prioresses of the other houses were still elected by the convent "according to old custom", under oath in the provost's presence. The sisters swore obedience to them (Sehling 23, p. 182). At Strasbourg the "mother or prioress" and six elder "council-mothers" were chosen and gave a promise (Sehling 20/1, p. 456). Both forms are in Chapter 13 §13.12.8.

### 16.7.6 Beguines, tertiaries, Brethren of the Common Life and confraternities

**Semi-religious communities.** The orders say little about the beguines, the tertiaries of the mendicant orders, the *Nollharden* or Lollards (lay brothers who nursed the sick and buried the dead), and the Brethren and Sisters of the Common Life. What they say is of three kinds:

- the houses were closed to new members;
- the existing members were maintained or bought out;
- the communities were turned to the service of the sick or the school.

No order creates a third order or a lay religious community.

**Closed to new members.** Württemberg's order of 1535 shut the "houses of the beguines and Lollards" with the monasteries (§16.7.4). The beguines might keep or divide what they had brought in, and sell the houses they had built themselves, with the duke's knowledge (Sehling 16, p. 80). Sehling's editors record four houses of tertiary sisters at Reutlingen before the Reformation (Sehling 17/2, p. 28, editors' introduction). In Württemberg only the Franciscan tertiaries of Weiler used their right to emigrate, and went as a community to a convent near Augsburg (Sehling 16, p. 50, editors' introduction).

**Heilbronn 1531: beguines as visitors of the sick.** Heilbronn gathered its beguines into one house and gave them a service, which comes closest in the corpus to an evangelical diaconate of women. **Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 8 December 1531** (Sehling 17/1, p. 298):

> Item, so sy dan also bey einander wonen werden, sollen sy uff ansuchen zu den kranken zu geen willig sein und die kranken gottlichem wort gemeß underweysen. Item, so wolle sich ain rate versehen, sy werden in bedacht, das irenthalb ain gut ansehen gepere, nit […] uff underschiedlicher klaydung hafften, sonder sonsten erbarlich beklayden und fleyssig in das wort Gottes zu horen geen.

Item, when they shall so dwell together, they shall be willing upon request to go to the sick, and to instruct the sick according to God's word. Item, a council trusteth that they, considering that a good appearance becometh them, will not […] cleave to a distinct clothing, but otherwise clothe themselves honestly, and go diligently to hear the word of God.

**Herford: the Brethren of the Common Life.** Herford had both a brothers' and a sisters' house of the Common Life, and its Brethren were early supporters of the Reformation (Sehling 21, p. 160, editors' introduction). Its church order of 1532 nonetheless counted the separate communion of such houses as sectarian. **Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532** (Sehling 21, pp. 173–174):

> dat enhet jo nicht Convenire, wen me sick van der gemeine affsundert inn Fraterhuse, Susterhuse und ander Rotten und Secten, sunder mit den gemeinen Christen tho der gedechtnisse des Heren sick vorgadderen tho dem bruck des Sacramentes.

That is surely not called *convenire* [to come together], when one separateth oneself from the congregation into brothers' houses, sisters' houses and other factions and sects; but [it is] to gather with the common Christians to the remembrance of the Lord, to the use of the sacrament.

**Confraternities.** The lay brotherhoods (*Bruderschaften*) and the Kalands, which had kept altars, lights and anniversary Masses, were dissolved and their goods put into the common chest from Leisnig in 1523 onward (§16.7.2). Lemgo in 1537 gave the revenues of the brotherhoods and of the Kaland of Corpus Christi to the schoolmaster and preachers (Sehling 21, p. 302). Nassau in 1537 kept a common meal for its clergy synod, but without the "disorderly feasting … as hitherto at the Kalands" (Sehling 10, p. 84).

**The answer in brief.** The Reformation in the Sehling corpus kept no third order and founded none. It turned the surviving beguines and *Seelfrauen* into nurses of the sick under the pastor. The lay confraternities were dissolved into the common chest, and the Brethren of the Common Life were absorbed into the parish and the school.

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## 16.8 Ordained or not: how each office was installed

**Words that do not settle the question.** "Ordain" (*ordiniren*, *ordinatio*) is not decisive in these texts:

- Lippe uses it of appointing deacons of the poor.
- The Bohemian Brethren (Hussite) use it of a handfast vow.
- Hesse (Moderate Reformed) uses it of a full rite with laying on of hands.

**How the table classifies.** The table below therefore classifies by what the rite actually does, in four degrees, from strongest to weakest:

- **hands**: laying on of hands, with prayer;
- **prayer**: public commendation with prayer, without hands;
- **vow**: a handfast vow (*Handgelübde*, *manu stipulata*) or an oath;
- **none**: appointment only.

| Office | Order | Elected or appointed by | Installation | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pastor or *Diaconus* (assistant minister) | Electoral Saxony 1580 | Called by the church; examined; confirmed by the synod | **hands** (superintendent), prayer; "by divine command" | §16.5.1 |
| Minister of the word | Pfalz-Zweibrücken 1539 | Congregation | **hands** (neighbouring pastors or "elders") | §16.5.4 |
| Minister of the word | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | — | **hands** (superintendent, ministers **and elders**) | §16.6.2 |
| Minister of the word | Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed) | Classis and seniors | "confirmation or ordination", public | §16.5.3 |
| Acolyte | Bohemian Brethren 1576 | Pastor; examined by synod | **vow** (*manu stipulata*), right hand of fellowship, blessing | §16.3.4 |
| Deacon (clerical) | Bohemian Brethren 1576 | Chosen from acolytes; examined by seniors | **hands**, vow, prayer, blessing (Acts 6:6) | §16.5.3 |
| Lay presbyter, *presbytera* | Bohemian Brethren 1576 | Free vote of the men (or women) | **vow** (*voce et stipulata manu*); place of honour | §16.6.4 |
| Deacon of the poor | Brunswick 1528, Hamburg 1529, Lübeck 1531 | — | **none** described | §16.5.2 |
| *Diaconi* | Pyritz 1539 | Council and guilds | **none**; "laden with no oath" | §16.5.2 |
| *Diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum* | Pomerania 1574 | Chosen under the pastors' eye | **vow** (oath) | §16.5.2 |
| *Leviten* (deacons of the poor) | Hadeln 1526 | — | **none** described | §16.5.2 |
| *Subdiaconi oder Bittherren* | Naumburg 1537 | Council and community | **none** described | §16.5.2 |
| Deacon of the poor | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | Ministers with council and congregation; probation | **hands** and prayer (Acts 6) | §16.5.3 |
| Deacon or almoner | Micron 1554/65 (Reformed) | Congregation | questions, prayer, **hands** | §16.5.3 |
| Deacon or almoner | Kurpfalz 1563, Wittgenstein 1581, Bentheim-Tecklenburg 1588/1619 (all Reformed) | —; confirmed by pastors and seniors | confirmation, rite not described | §16.5.3 |
| Deacon, senior, sexton | Nassau-Dillenburg 1582 (Reformed) | Presbytery; confirmed by classis | confirmation and admonition | §16.5.3 |
| Lay elder | Hesse (Ziegenhain) 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | Each church | **prayer** and exhortation ("sanctify their office") | §16.6.2 |

| Office | Order | Elected or appointed by | Installation | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lay elder | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | Ministers with council and congregation | **hands** (pastor and ministers), prayer; "ordained" | §16.6.2 |
| Lay elder | Micron 1554/65 (Reformed) | Congregation | questions, prayer, **hands** | §16.6.3 |
| Lay elder | Kurpfalz 1592 (also Ysenburg-Ronneburg 1592; both Reformed) | Congregation | questions, prayer, **hands** (minister and elders) | §16.6.3 |
| Censor (elder) | Pfalz-Veldenz 1574 | — | **prayer** from the pulpit; "set into this high office" | §16.6.3 |
| Lay elder | Kurpfalz about 1601 (Reformed) | Yearly | **vow** (handfast), **prayer** of the congregation | §16.6.3 |
| Lay elder | Hanau-Münzenberg 1609 (Reformed) | — | **vow** (handfast), **prayer**; "the office of elders is of God" | §16.6.3 |
| Lay elder | Solms 1594 (Reformed) | — | **vow** (oath) | §16.6.3 |
| Censor | Wild- and Rhinegraviate 1603 | Pastor and old censors | **vow** (oath), confirmed by superintendent | §16.6.3 |
| Churchwarden (*Kirchenpfleger*) | Strasbourg 1553 | — | — | §16.6.1 |
| Churchwarden | Memmingen 1532 (Moderate Reformed), Dinkelsbühl 1574, Augsburg 1591 | Council (and citizens) | **none** described | §16.6.5 |
| Sexton (*Opfermann*) | Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | Pastor and elders, with the superintendent | **none** | §16.3.5 |
| Sexton and sacristan (*custos*) | Anhalt (Törten) 1594 (Philippist) | Prince's councillors with the superintendent; for one year, renewable at Michaelmas | **none**; written appointment | §16.7.1 |
| Bell-ringer, keeper of the vessels | Sayn 1590 | —; must be well known or give surety | **none** | §16.7.1 |
| *Sigrist* | Strasbourg 1531 (Moderate Reformed) | Pastors and parish churchwardens | **none** described | §16.7.1 |
| Convent deaconess (almoner), sacristaness and other sisters' offices | Keppel 1570 | Assigned by the *domina* | **none** | §16.7.3, §16.7.5 |
| *Seelfrau* (sick-woman) | Regensburg 1543, Nördlingen 1544 | Council; examined by the pastor (Nördlingen) | **none** | §16.7.3 |
| Beguines as visitors of the sick | Heilbronn 1531 | Council | **none**; troth "in place of an oath" to declare their goods | §16.7.6 |
| Monk staying in the cloister | Württemberg 1535, Esslingen 1535 | — | **none**; no new professions | §16.7.4 |

| Office | Order | Elected or appointed by | Installation | Section |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| | (Moderate Reformed) | | | |
| Novice or scholar of an evangelical monastery | Ravengiersburg 1560 | Duke and prior | **none**; no vow | §16.7.4 |
| Nun | Keppel 1570 | Count; parents, *domina* and candidate questioned | **vow** (oath with hand on breast), sermon, clothing, *Veni Sancte Spiritus*, exhortation, *Te Deum* | §16.7.5 |
| Nun | Lüneburg 1574 | Duke's foreknowledge and command | clothing in a plain gown; rite not described | §16.7.5 |
| *Domina* | Keppel 1570 | Convent proposes two or three; count confirms and may depose | **vow** (promise in place of oath); presented with an exhortation | §16.7.5 |
| Abbess, prioress | Schleswig-Holstein 1610 | Convent, sworn to choose well, in the provost's presence | **vow** (oath); the sisters swear obedience | §16.7.5 |
| Mother (prioress) and six council-mothers | Strasbourg 1555 | Chosen from the eldest and fittest | **vow** (promise) | §16.7.5 |

**Summary.** Laying on of hands was used for four groups:

- ministers of the word, everywhere;
- deacons of the poor, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed) and in Micron (Reformed);
- lay elders, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), Micron and Kurpfalz 1592 (Reformed);
- the Bohemian Brethren's clerical deacons (Hussite).

It was not used for:

- sacristans, sick-women, nuns, convent heads or the scholars of the evangelical monasteries;
- Lutheran deacons of the poor or churchwardens;
- the Reformed elders of the Kurpfalz *Presbyterordnung*, Hanau or Solms, and the elders of Lutheran Veldenz;
- any minor grade, including the Bohemian acolytes.

**Answer to the question asked.** Were ruling elders ordained? Yes, in Hesse 1566 (Moderate Reformed), the London-Norden order of Micron and the Palatinate form of 1592 (both Reformed). Elsewhere they were installed with prayer, a handfast vow or an oath, and none of these used the language of ordination except Veldenz, which uses it of the apostles.

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## 16.9 Table by order

The table summarises, for each order quoted, the offices below or beside the pastorate that it knows. The columns are:

- **Minor, liturgical or religious**: minor orders, liturgical roles, sacristans, and religious and semi-religious persons (§16.7).
- **Deacon**: the form of diaconate.
- **Elder**: the form of eldership.
- **Kept, abolished or forbidden**: what is said to be kept, abolished or forbidden.

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae*, 1523 | 1 | Candles and incense free | — | — | Neither forbidden nor required |

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523 | 1 | Brotherhoods of the Kaland, St Anne, shoemakers | — | — | Dissolved into the common chest |
| Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, 1524 | 11 | Ministrant | — | — | Kept |
| Hadeln, *Kirchenordnung*, 1526 | 5 | — | Lay *leviten* of the poor | — | Created |
| Homberg, 1526 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | Deacon's and subdeacon's vestments | Deacon of the poor only | Bishop = presbyter | Mass-deacons and subdeacons rejected as unscriptural |
| Brunswick (Bugenhagen), 1528 | 6/1 | No tonsure or deacon's coat | Lay deacons of the chest and the poor | Bishops = preachers | Created; no ministry of word |
| Nürnberg, report for Goslar, 1528 | 7/2.2 | Levites read the lesson and exhort | — | — | Kept |
| Hamburg, 1529 | 5 | Sexton hired by deacons | Sixteen lay deacons of the poor, plus treasury deacons | — | Created |
| Heilbronn, 1530 | 17/1 | — | Two *Diaconi* (assistant preachers) distribute | — | Kept |
| Heilbronn, beguine houses, 1531 | 17/1 | Beguines to visit the sick; no distinct clothing | — | — | Kept as one house |
| Strasbourg, *Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | *Sigristen* appointed by pastors and churchwardens | — | — | Kept |
| Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed) | 12 | — | — | *Kirchenpfleger*, no temporal jurisdiction | Limited |
| Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 21 | Brothers' and sisters' houses of the Common Life | — | — | Separate communion rejected |
| Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535 | 16 | Monks, nuns, novices, beguines, Lollards | — | — | Admissions forbidden; novices sent home |
| Esslingen, Franciscan convent, 1535 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2 | Friars | — | — | Free to marry; those staying maintained |

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Freiberg, Visitation articles, 1537 | 1 | Cross, tonsure | — | — | Abolished as human ordinances |
| Naumburg, St Wenzel, 1537 | 2 | — | Twelve lay *subdiaconi oder Bittherren* | — | Created |
| Lippe, 1538 | 21 | Incense abolished; vestments and lights free | Lay *diaconi* of the poor | — | Created |
| Pyritz, 1539 | 4 | — | Four lay *diaconi*, no oath | — | Created |
| Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1 | History of minor orders; exorcism a gift | Deacon apostolic; schoolmasters in the deacons' place | Two orders of presbyters | Minor orders treated as later additions |
| Ziegenhain, *Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | — | — | Lay elders, confirmed with prayer | Created |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, 1539 | 18 | — | — | Pastors = bishops = elders | — |
| Brandenburg, 1540 | 3 | Ministrants in dalmatics; lights; cross and lights at funerals | — | — | Kept where clergy suffice |
| Stendal, 1541 | 3 | Cross before procession | — | — | Kept |
| Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542 | 13 | Two levites (gospeller, epistoler) | — | — | Kept |
| Goslar, convent of Frankenberg, 1542 | 7/2.2 | Nuns | — | — | No admission to the habit; free to marry |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, 1543 | 13 | Ministrants; deacon and subdeacon read, deacon gives cup | — | — | Kept "where there are ministrants" |
| Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1 | Sexton, not women, at the font | — | — | Kept |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543 | 13 | *Seelfrauen* and men for the sick and dying | — | — | Kept under the word |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544 | 12 | Sick-women examined by the pastor | — | — | Kept |

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545 | 1 | — | — | Bishops a grade above priests by human foresight | — |
| Strasbourg, Marbach, 1553 | 20/1 | — | — | *Kirchenpfleger* = *seniores* | Created |
| Regensburg, Jonas, 1553 | 13 | Rota of ordained ministers as ministrants or deacons | — | — | Kept |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15 | Sexton carries chalice, corporal, surplice to the sick | — | — | Kept |
| Regensburg, 29 April 1554 | 13 | Levites and Mass vestments | — | — | Abolished |
| Micron, *Ordinancien*, 1554/65 (Reformed) | 7/1 | — | Deacons of the poor, hands | Ruling elders, hands; one presiding superintendent | Created |
| Strasbourg, mandate on the women's convents, 1555 | 20/1 | Nuns; prioress and council-mothers | — | — | Admission by the council |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9 | Sexton carries the cross before the coffin | — | — | Kept |
| Herrenalb, *Statuten*, 1556 | 16 | Evangelical conventuals and novices | — | — | Kept as a school |
| Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560 | 9 | — | — | "Elders" = pastors | — |
| Württemberg, 1559 | 16 | — | *Diacon*, *Subdiacon* (ministers) | — | Kept as benefices |
| Rostock, *Conformitas*, 1560–76 | 5 | Boys read the epistle | — | — | — |
| Ravengiersburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1560 | 19/2 | Novices trained for the ministry | — | — | Kept as a school; Latin chant allowed |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78 | 11 | Levites | — | Two clerical *seniores* | Levites forbidden |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8 | Sexton as *ianitor*, *aedituus* | Deacons of the poor, ordained with hands | Ruling elders, ordained with hands; elders lay hands on ministers | Created |

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?) | 13 | Levites, vestments, lights | — | — | Abolished |
| Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569 | 6/1 | Nuns' cowl, veil and crown | — | — | Habit to be laid aside |
| Keppel, *Ordnung für das Kloster*, 1570 | 10 | Nuns clothed with oath; *domina*; *diaconissa*, *custorin* | — | — | Kept, reformed |
| Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572 | 5 | Nuns' habit and consecration books | — | — | Consecrated habit abolished |
| Halle, 1573(?) | 2 | — | Pastor and two *diaconi*; *unterdiaconi* | — | Kept |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, 1574 | 18 | — | (Acts 6) | Censors, prayer | Created |
| Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574 | 4 | Lay *diaconi* keep the altar and its ornament | *Diaconi ecclesiae et pauperum*, oath | Clerical *seniores* | Created |
| Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1574 | 6/1 | Nuns' clothing under the duke; cowl, veil and crown | — | — | Plain habit |
| Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1576 | 4 | Acolytes (ordained grade) | Clerical deacons, hands | Lay presbyters and *presbyterae*, handfast | Kept; deacon "not to be cast out" |
| Electoral Saxony, 1580 | 1 | Bell-ringers' sale of font water and hosts forbidden | *Diaconat*, *Subdiaconat*; same ordination as pastor | — | Diaconate may be dispensed |
| Wittgenstein, 1581 (Reformed) | 22 | — | *Diaconi oder Almusenpfleger* | — | Created |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, 1582 (Reformed) | 10 | *Aeditui* elected by presbytery | Deacons of the poor | Seniors; four offices | Created |
| Frankfurt, Dutch congregation (Augsburg Confession), 1585 (Lutheran) | 9 | — | Two *diaconi* | — | Created |
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, 1588/1619 (Reformed) | 22 | Baptismal exorcism | *Diaconi oder Almusenpfleger* | Seniors | Exorcism abolished |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1 | Bell-ringer keeps chalices and ornaments | — | — | Kept |
| Augsburg, *Vergleichsartikel*, 1591 | 12 | — | — | Six *Kirchenpfleger* | — |

| Order | Volume | Minor, liturgical or religious | Deacon | Elder | Kept, abolished or forbidden |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11 | Subdeacon reads epistle | *Subdiaconus* (minister) | — | Kept |
| Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 1592 (Reformed) | 19/2 | — | — | Ruling elders, hands | Created |
| Anhalt, sexton of Törten, 1594 (Philippist) | 2 | Sexton prepares altar and font, vests the pastor | — | — | Kept |
| Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed) | 14 | — | — | Yearly elders, handfast vow and prayer; Matthew 18 | Created |
| Solms-Laubach, 1603 | 9 | — | — | Elders, oath | Created |
| Wild- and Rhinegraviate, 1603 | 19/2 | — | — | Censors, oath | Created |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, 1609 (Reformed) | 10 | — | — | Elders, handfast vow and prayer; "of God" | Created |
| Schwäbisch Hall, 1543/1615 | 17/1 | Cross before coffin, "significatively" | — | — | Allowed |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610 | 23 | Abbess and prioress elected under oath | — | — | Kept |

## 16.10 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted or cited in this chapter is listed below by region. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted or cited.

Passages from Sehling's own introductions are marked "editors' introduction".

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Luther, *Formula missae et communionis pro ecclesia Wittembergensi*, 1523 | 1, p. 5 | 2 | 16.4.4 |
| Freiberg, *Visitationsartikel* of Dr Jacob Schenk, 1537 | 1, p. 466 | 48 | 16.3.3 |
| Freiberg, *Artikel*, 1538 | 1, p. 468 | 49 | 16.4.5 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Wittenbergische Reformation*, 1545 | 1, pp. 217–218 | 20 | 16.5.4 |
| Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580 | 1, pp. 375, 381–383, 426 | 44 | 16.3.3, 16.5.1, 16.5.4, 16.7.1 |
| Naumburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung für die St. Wenzelskirche*, 1537 | 2, p. 64 | 1219 | 16.5.2 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Halle, *Kirchen-Ordnung der christlichen Gemein zu Hall in Sachsen*, 1573(?) | 2, pp. 441–442 | 1257 | 16.3.3, 16.5.1 |
| Leisnig, *Ordnung eines gemeinen Kastens*, 1523 | 1, p. 599 | 102 | 16.7.2, 16.7.6 |
| Schönburg, *Kirchen-Ordnung* of Johann Pfeffinger, 18 October 1542 | 2, p. 176 | 1235 | 16.7.1 |
| Anhalt, *Ordnung der deutschen Gesänge*, before 1551 | 2, p. 555 | 1262 | 16.4.5 |
| Anhalt, *Ordnung für den Küster zu Törten*, 8 November 1594 (Philippist) | 2, pp. 579–580 | 1262 | 16.7.1 |

**Brandenburg, Pomerania and the North Sea and Baltic cities**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg, *Kirchenordnung* of Joachim II, 1540 | 3, pp. 71, 81 | 1746 | 16.4.1, 16.4.4, 16.4.5 |
| Stendal, ordinance of the visitors of the Mark Brandenburg, 1541 | 3, p. 314 | 1785 | 16.4.5 |
| Prenzlau, *Abschied*, 1557 | 3, p. 261 | 1776 | 16.4.5 |
| Pyritz, *Abschied*, 1539 | 4, p. 519 | 1879 | 16.5.2 |
| Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574 | 4, pp. 489, 491 | 1868 | 16.5.2, 16.6.5, 16.7.2 |
| Rostock, *Conformitas ceremoniarum in singulis templis ecclesiae Rostochiensis*, 1560–1576 | 5, p. 289 | 1936 | 16.3.5 |
| Hamburg, *Hamburger Kirchenordnung*, 1529 | 5, pp. 512–514, 535 | 1960 | 16.3.3, 16.3.5, 16.5.2 |
| Lübeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1531 | 5, p. 359 | 1949 | 16.1, 16.5.2 |
| Hadeln, *Hadelner Kirchenordnung*, 1526 | 5, p. 472 | 1955 | 16.5.2 |
| Mecklenburg, *Klosterordnung*, 1572 | 5, pp. 254–255 | 1926 | 16.7.5 |
| Schleswig-Holstein, *Klosterordnung für Frauenklöster*, after 1610 | 23, p. 182 | 1584 | 16.7.5 |

**Lower Saxony, East Frisia and Westphalia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brunswick, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Bugenhagen, 1528 | 6/1, p. 449 | 1983 | 16.3.3, 16.5.2, 16.5.4 |
| Hildesheim, editors' introduction on Bugenhagen's order of 1544 | 7/2.1, p. 811 | 2132 | 16.1, 16.5.2, 16.5.4 |
| East Frisia, editors' introduction to Micron's *Ordinancien* (Reformed) | 7/1, pp. 554–555 | 2115 | 16.5.3 |
| Micron, *Ordinancien* (1554) 1565 (Reformed) | 7/1, pp. 583, 587–588, 596–598 | 2116 | 16.5.3, 16.6.3 |
| Lippe, *Lippische Kirchenordnung*, 1538 | 21, pp. 318, 335 | 1459 | 16.4.4, 16.5.2, 16.8 |
| Wittgenstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 (Reformed) | 22, p. 201 | 1502 | 16.5.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bentheim-Tecklenburg, *Bentheim-Tecklenburger Kirchenordnung*, 1588/1619 (Reformed) | 22, pp. 269, 276 | 1508 | 16.3.5, 16.5.3 |
| Brunswick-Wolfenbüttel, *Klosterordnung*, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 324–326 | 1978 | 16.7.5 |
| Lüneburg, *Klosterordnung* of Duke William the Younger, 1574 | 6/1, p. 622 | 2010 | 16.7.5 |
| Goslar, *Ordnung für das Frauenkloster Frankenberg*, 1542 | 7/2.2, p. 275 | 2198 | 16.7.5 |
| Lemgo, *Lemgoer Kirchenordnung*, 1537 | 21, p. 302 | 1458 | 16.7.6 |
| Lippe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1571 | 21, p. 447 | 1462 | 16.7.1 |
| Herford, *Kirchenordnung*, 1532 | 21, pp. 173–174 | 1442 | 16.7.6 |
| Herford, editors' introduction | 21, p. 160 | 1441 | 16.7.6 |

**Hesse, the Wetterau and the Middle Rhine**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse, *Homberger Kirchenordnung*, 1526 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 46 | 2247 | 16.3.2 |
| Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 103 | 2252 | 16.6.2 |
| Hesse, *Kirchenordnung*, 1566 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, pp. 195, 205, 207–211 | 2257 | 16.3.5, 16.5.3, 16.6.2 |
| Solms, *Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1594 (Reformed) | 9, p. 338 | 2311 | 16.6.3 |
| Erbach, *Erbacher Kirchenordnung*, 1560 | 9, p. 446 | 2316 | 16.6.5 |
| Frankfurt, *Stiftungsbrief des Armenkastens der Niederländischen Gemeinde A. C.*, 1585 (Lutheran) | 9, p. 604 | 2332 | 16.5.2 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 23 January 1582 (Reformed) | 10, p. 160 | 184 | 16.5.3, 16.6.3 |
| Ysenburg-Ronneburg, *Memorial zur Kirchenzuchtordnung*, 1592 (Reformed) | 10, p. 601 | 223 | 16.6.3 |
| Hanau-Münzenberg, *Presbyteriumsordnung*, 1609 (Reformed) | 10, p. 508 | 211 | 16.6.3 |
| Wild- and Rhinegraviate, *Kirchenordnung*, 1603 | 19/2, p. 600 | 1121 | 16.6.3 |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung*, 1556 | 9, p. 256 | 2300 | 16.4.5 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1537 | 10, p. 84 | 169 | 16.7.6 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Ordnung für das Kloster Keppel*, 1570 | 10, pp. 141–142 | 181 | 16.7.3, 16.7.5 |
| Sayn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1590 | 19/1, p. 438 | 1090 | 16.7.1 |

**The Palatinates**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 13, pp. 70–71, 75 | 386 | 16.4.2 |
| Kurpfalz, editors' introduction on the discipline dispute, 1568–1570 (Reformed) | 14, p. 53 | 468 | 16.1, 16.6.3 |
| Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed) | 14, pp. 595, 598 | 518 | 16.6.3 |
| Kurpfalz, *Einführung der Senioren*, 9 December 1592 (Reformed) | 19/2, pp. 789–790 | 1155 | 16.6.3 |
| Kurpfalz, editors' introduction to the *Einführung der Senioren* (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 695 | 1133 | 16.6.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Kirchenordnung „Form und Ordnung“*, 1539 | 18, p. 63 | 965 | 16.5.4 |
| Pfalz-Veldenz, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574 | 18, p. 573 | 1011 | 16.6.3 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, p. 208 | 404 | 16.7.2 |
| Pfalz-Simmern, *Klosterordnung Ravengiersburg*, 1560 | 19/2, p. 658 | 1125 | 16.7.4 |
| Heidelberg, *Spitalordnung*, 1594 (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 827 | 1163 | 16.7.3 |

**Franconia, Bavaria, Swabia and Alsace**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nürnberg, *Gottesdienstordnung der Pfarrkirchen*, 1524 | 11, p. 52 | 249 | 16.4.1 |
| Nürnberg, *Bericht der Stadt Nürnberg für den Goslarer Rat*, 30 March 1528 | 7/2.2, p. 230 | 2186 | 16.3.5, 16.4.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kapitelsordnung*, 1565/78 | 11, pp. 347, 350, 357 | 283 | 16.4.3, 16.6.5 |
| Hof, *Ordo ecclesiasticus*, 1592 | 11, p. 425 | 294 | 16.3.5 |
| Augsburg, *Vergleichsartikel*, 1591 | 12, pp. 109–110 | 341 | 16.6.5 |
| Dinkelsbühl, *Kirchenpflegeordnung*, 1574 | 12, p. 131 | 348 | 16.6.5 |
| Memmingen, *Zuchtordnung*, 1532 (Moderate Reformed) | 12, p. 248 | 365 | 16.6.5 |
| Regensburg, *Wahrhaftiger Bericht*, 1542 | 13, pp. 391, 393 | 432 | 16.4.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung unter Justus Jonas*, 1553 | 13, pp. 419–421 | 440 | 16.4.2 |
| Regensburg, *Warum die leviten- und meßgewand sollen abgetan werden*, 29 April 1554 | 13, p. 432 | 443 | 16.4.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1567(?) | 13, p. 480 | 450 | 16.4.3, 16.4.4 |
| Württemberg, *Ordnung der Besetzung von Kirchendienerstellen*, 1559 | 16, p. 348 | 683 | 16.3.3 |
| Heilbronn, *„Confessio Heilbronnensis“ und Kirchenordnung*, 1530 | 17/1, p. 285 | 770 | 16.4.2 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* 1543/1615 | 17/1, p. 173 | 763 | 16.4.5 |
| Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, Latin version, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, pp. 304, 310 | 1308 | 16.3.1, 16.6.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* of Johannes Marbach, 1553 | 20/1, p. 441 | 1321 | 16.6.1 |
| Nürnberg, *Agendbüchlein* of Veit Dietrich, 1545 | 11, p. 531 | 297 | 16.7.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Kirchenvisitation*, 1536 | 11, p. 320 | 277 | 16.7.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594 | 11, p. 391 | 291 | 16.7.1 |
| Nördlingen, *Kirchenordnung Kaspar Löners*, 1544 | 12, p. 315 | 372 | 16.7.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung des Noppus*, 1543 | 13, p. 410 | 436 | 16.7.3 |
| Wolfstein, *Christliche Instructio* of Thomas Stieber, 1574 | 13, p. 582 | 463 | 16.7.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1553 | 15, p. 73 | 539 | 16.7.1 |
| Württemberg, editors' introduction | 16, p. 50 | 644 | 16.7.6 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Württemberg, *Klosterordnung*, 1535 | 16, pp. 79–80 | 647 | 16.7.4, 16.7.6 |
| Württemberg, *Mandat gegen Aufnahme von Novizen in den Klöstern*, 1552 | 16, p. 199 | 669 | 16.7.4 |
| Herrenalb, *Statuten für das Zisterzienserkloster*, 1556 | 16, p. 317 | 678 | 16.7.4 |
| Württemberg, *Ordnung der deutschen Schulen*, 1559 | 17/1, p. 585 | 813 | 16.7.1 |
| Baden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1533 | 16, p. 510 | 702 | 16.4.4 |
| Baden, *Kirchenordnungsmandat*, 1601 | 16, p. 551 | 713 | 16.7.1 |
| Heilbronn, *Instruktion zur Zusammenlegung beider Beginenhäuser*, 1531 | 17/1, p. 298 | 776 | 16.7.3, 16.7.6 |
| Heilbronn, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 17/1, p. 315 | 781 | 16.7.1, 16.7.2 |
| Reutlingen, editors' introduction | 17/2, p. 28 | 825 | 16.7.6 |
| Esslingen, *Ordnung für die Konventualen im Barfüßerkloster*, 1535 (Moderate Reformed) | 17/2, p. 382 | 882 | 16.7.4 |
| Strasbourg, *Ordnung der Kirchenpfleger*, 1531 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/1, p. 226 | 1292 | 16.7.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Mandat zu den noch bestehenden Frauenklöstern*, 1555 | 20/1, pp. 454, 456 | 1323 | 16.7.5 |

**Poland**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Bohemian Brethren, *Ordo ecclesiasticus in unitate fratrum Bohemorum*, 1576 (Hussite) | 4, pp. 275–276, 279, 289 | 1846 | 16.3.4, 16.5.3, 16.6.4, 16.7.3 |

# Chapter 17. Confessional Subscription

This chapter covers how the evangelical church orders of the sixteenth and early seventeenth centuries bound people to the confessions, as printed in Emil Sehling's *Die evangelischen Kirchenordnungen des XVI. Jahrhunderts*. It asks five questions:

- Which documents did each order name as its rule of doctrine, its *corpus doctrinae* or *norma doctrinae*? Was it Scripture alone, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, Melanchthon's *Loci* and *Corpus doctrinae*, a territorial corpus, the Formula of Concord or the Book of Concord, or a local confession?
- How was a minister bound to these documents? By a list of books to buy, a question at the visitation, an examination, a written *Revers*, a sworn oath, a "Yea" at ordination, or a subscription with his own hand?
- How did this differ from one territory to another, and how did it change over time? The main stages are the 1530s, the Interim years, the age of the territorial *corpora doctrinae* in the 1560s and 1570s, the Formula of Concord campaign of 1577–1580, and the refusals and Reformed reorientations that followed.
- Were lay people ever bound in the same way? This covers the profession and vow at confirmation, admission to communion, godparents, admission as a burgher, and magistrates and other officials.
- What did the orders say about refusers and dissenters?

The findings are summarised in §17.1, and the method and its cautions are described in §17.2. §17.3 is a glossary of the documents the orders name. §17.4 sets out the forms of binding. §§17.5–17.16 go through the territories region by region, each in date order. §17.17 covers the laity. §17.18 is a table by order, and §17.19 a concordance of every order quoted.

**Related chapters.** Several subjects are treated more fully elsewhere and are only cited here:

- the rites at which the vows were taken (confirmation, ordination, installation, and the oaths of sextons, schoolmasters, churchwardens and magistrates): Chapter 13, §§13.6, 13.10–13.13;
- the examination, trial sermon and continuing study of ministers, and the consistories that examined them: Chapter 15, §§15.5, 15.7;
- catechesis before first communion and before marriage: Chapter 15, §15.11;
- how deacons, elders and the other church offices were installed: Chapter 16, §16.8;
- the confessional tradition of every order: Chapter 1, §1.3.

The abbreviations for the confessional writings are listed in the Conventions.

## 17.1 Summary of findings

### 17.1.1 The main findings

**1. There was no single confessional standard until 1580, and not everywhere after it.** Every territory had a rule of doctrine, but what that rule held varied a great deal. In outline it moved through five stages:

- **To about 1540: Scripture and the prince.** The earliest oaths bound a pastor to preach "the holy gospel and word of God" purely, together with obedience to his lord. Brandenburg-Ansbach's priest's oath of 1528 is the model (§17.14.1). Heilbronn's council swore in 1530 to stand together in matters "of the gospel" (§17.17.5). Confessions are not yet named.
- **About 1540 to 1560: the Augsburg Confession and Melanchthon.** The CA and its Apology become the measure of preaching. The orders add Melanchthon's *Loci communes* as the textbook from which ministers are examined. This is so in Albertine Saxony in 1540 and 1557 (§17.5.1), Württemberg in 1547 (§17.13.1), Pomerania (§17.7.4) and Strasbourg's examination of 1549, issued under the Interim (§17.15.1). The norm is still given chiefly as a list of books a parish must buy.
- **The 1560s and 1570s: territorial *corpora doctrinae*.** Princes and cities gathered their own bodies of doctrine, which pastors had to own, follow and often subscribe. These were the Philippist *Corpus doctrinae* of 1560 (adopted in Electoral Saxony, Kurland, Brieg, Oldenburg, Bremen and Hesse, the last two Philippist), the Pomeranian, the Prussian (1567), the Thuringian, the Wolfenbüttel *Corpus Julium* (1576), the Brunswick city corpus (1571), the Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma doctrinae* (1573) and the Hohenlohe corpus (1578). Some local confessions also served as corpora: Mansfeld 1565, the Lüneburg Articles of 1561, Danzig's *Notel* of 1562, the Strasbourg Concord of 1563 and Ravensburg's local "formula concordiae" of 1578.

- **1577 to about 1600: the Formula and the Book of Concord.** The FC was put to every minister for signature in Electoral Saxony, Brandenburg, Württemberg, Mecklenburg, Henneberg, Mansfeld, Pfalz-Neuburg, the Upper Palatinate, Ansbach and many Swabian and Franconian cities, and it was written into church orders such as Hoya's (1581). Later orders made signing the BoC a condition of admission to office (§§17.5.3, 17.6.2, 17.9, 17.13, 17.14). Ordination questions took the FC into the vow itself, answered with "Yea" (Henneberg 1582, Waldeck, Frankfurt 1589 and Strasbourg 1598).
- **The refusers and the Reformed turn.** Some refused the FC outright: Anhalt (§17.6.6), Hesse (Philippist), Danzig, Nürnberg and its neighbours, Gottorp and the Danish lands, Colmar (Moderate Reformed) and Bremen (Philippist). Pomerania kept its own corpus and took only three points of the FC against the Calvinists, in 1593. Some ceased to require it when they turned Reformed: Kurpfalz after 1583 and the Upper Palatinate in 1585. Others kept a pre-1577 norm or replaced the FC with a local formula, such as Hohenlohe's *Gründlicher Bericht* of 1603–1605. Where the Reformed took over, the CA *variata* or Scripture alone became the stated norm. The CA was understood in the Frankfurt Recess and Naumburg sense, and the Heidelberg Catechism replaced Luther's.

**2. The canon grew by accretion.** The usual sequence of additions to Scripture and the three creeds was:

- the CA, from 1530;
- the Apology;
- the SA, named increasingly from the 1550s, often "as signed at Smalcald 1537";
- Luther's catechisms;
- then either Melanchthon's corpus or a territorial corpus;
- and finally the FC or the whole BoC.

Many orders show this growth inside their own textual history. Ansbach's 1528 oath carries apparatus variants for 1570, 1573 and 1588 (§17.14.1). The Hohenlohe KO of 1578 gained a handwritten "7. Die formulam concordiae" (§17.13.3). The Kurpfalz formula of 1556 was rewritten in 1580 and 1586 (§17.12.1).

**3. "Unaltered" and "in its true sense" are the signs of party.**

- *Gnesio-Lutheran or FC party.* Adjectives such as *unverändert*, *ungeändert*, *uralt*, *wie anno 30 übergeben*, "in its right, true sense" and "as explained in the Apology, the SA and the catechisms" mark the Gnesio-Lutheran or FC party. Examples are Wolfenbüttel 1569 (§17.9.1), Verden 1606, Osnabrück 1610 and Hoya 1581.
- *Philippist or Reformed party.* Phrases such as "as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg", the *Corpus doctrinae Philippi* and the *Repetitio* (*Confessio Saxonica*) mark the Philippist or Reformed party. Examples are Bremen 1572 (Philippist), the Upper Palatinate 1585 (Reformed) and Kurland 1570 (Lutheran).

**4. The form of binding hardened.** The forms run from a book list, through a question at the visitation and a promise, to a sworn oath and a signature in one's own hand. In the oldest orders the confession appears as books a parish must buy (Ernestine Saxony 1554, Albertine Saxony 1557). Later orders demand:

- a public confession at admission (Ernestine Saxony 1569, Strasbourg from 1562);
- a written promise or *Revers* (Nassau-Diez 1564);
- an oath on the confessions (Ansbach, Peine/Gottorp 1574, Wimpfen, Hessen-Darmstadt 1617, Transylvania);
- subscription "with his own hand" (Electoral Saxony 1580, Regensburg 1572/88, Hildesheim 1593, Wimpfen).

The Kurpfalz (Lutheran and Reformed in turn) and Pfalz-Neuburg *Bestallungen* bind "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath" (§17.12.1). §17.4 gives the forms in full.

**5. Subscription reached beyond the clergy, but not to the common people.** Superintendents, consistorial assessors and professors were bound as a matter of course. So in some cities were burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries (Hildesheim 1593), the chamberlain and council (Regensburg 1572/88), and schoolmasters in many places. **No order requires ordinary lay people to subscribe the CA or the FC.** The laity were bound in other ways (§17.17):

- by the catechism examination before first communion and before marriage;
- by a public profession and vow at confirmation, chiefly in Hesse from 1539 and Strasbourg (both Moderate Reformed), the Reformed refugee churches and Electoral Saxony's confirmation of the baptismal faith;
- by the confession and exploration required before each communion (Schweinfurt 1543, after the CA itself);
- by rules for godparents and for admission as a burgher.

The Reformed orders alone required an explicit "confession of the Reformed doctrine" before the Supper (Nassau-Dillenburg 1582, Reformed, §17.17.2).

### 17.1.2 The pattern by region

| Region | Before the FC | The FC and BoC | After 1580 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine (Electoral) Saxony | CA, Apol, *Loci*; *CPhil* (1560/66) | Signed 1577; BoC signature required for office (1580) | BoC norm |
| Ernestine Saxony | CA, SA; Weimar *Confutationsbuch* 1558/59 | Adopted 1580 | BoC |
| Henneberg, Mansfeld, Magdeburg | Own corpora; Mansfeld confession 1565 | Signed | Ordination vow includes the FC (Henneberg 1582) |
| Anhalt | CA 1530/33, SA, catechisms | Refused | Reformed after 1596 |
| Silesia (Brieg) | — | — | *CPhil* and the Mecklenburg agenda named beside the CA (1592) |
| Prussia | *Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* 1567 | — | "Our church's unanimous Christian confession" (1584) |
| Danzig, Thorn | *Notel* 1562; CA and catechisms | BoC forbidden to be "canonised" (1586) | *Notel* |
| Pomerania | *Corpus Pomeranicum* (1564); synodal promise by handshake (1574) | Not signed | Three points of the FC against the Calvinists taken by the synod (1593, from Sehling's introduction) |
| Kurland | *CPhil* with the SA (1570) | — | — |
| Mecklenburg, Rostock | CA, Apol, SA, Mecklenburg KO, Lüneburg Articles | Signed 1577 | FC |
| Lauenburg | — | — | CA, Apol, SA, catechisms "or the FC" (1585) |
| Schleswig-Holstein (Gottorp) | Oath on CA, Apol, SA, catechisms (1574) | Refused (royal edict 1580) | New oath on Scripture alone (1607) |
| Brunswick city | City corpus 1571 (CA, Apol, SA, catechisms, against the errors condemned in the Lüneburg Articles) | The council sided against the duke over signing (Sehling's introduction) | City corpus |
| Wolfenbüttel | KO 1569; *Corpus Julium* 1576 | — | *Corpus Julium* signed with the KO (Göttingen, 1601) |
| Lüneburg (duchy, city) | KO 1564; Lüneburg Articles 1561; city corpus with the 1548 confession (1575); *Corpus Wilhelminum* 1576 | — | *Corpus Wilhelminum* still signed in the 17th century (Sehling's introduction) |
| Hoya | — | FC in the KO (1581) | — |
| Goslar, Hildesheim | — | FC and Erfurt Apology; officials sign (1593) | Lower Saxon Confession 1571 in corpus (Goslar |

| Region | Before the FC | The FC and BoC | After 1580 |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | 1591/95) |
| Verden, Osnabrück | — | — | CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, catechisms (1606); CA, Wittenberg Concord, SA, BoC (1610) |
| Oldenburg | CA, Apol, SA, catechism and *CPhil* (1573) | FC added in *Bestallungen* (1586) | FC; anti-Calvinist visitation 1609 |
| Bremen (Philippist 1556–1575; Reformed from 1582) | CA, *CPhil*, Frankfurt Recess | Refused | Reformed |
| East Frisia | — | FC in a Lutheran congregation (1583) | Only "the CA" by treaty (1599; a Reformed–Lutheran treaty) |
| Soest | — | — | Corpus includes the FC; subscription required (1590) |
| Hesse (Moderate Reformed to 1566, then Philippist; after the division Hessen-Kassel Reformed, Hessen-Darmstadt Lutheran) | CA, Apol, SA, catechism, *CPhil* (1571) | Rejected jointly by the landgraves (editors' account; but see Darmstadt, §17.11) | Variant positions; Darmstadt oath on the unaltered CA (1617); Kassel anti-ubiquity oath (1598) |
| Waldeck, Frankfurt | — | FC in the ordination vow | — |
| Nassau (Dillenburg Reformed from 1581) | *Revers* on CA and *Loci* (1564) | Not adopted | Reformed (Dillenburg 1582); Weilburg unaltered CA |
| Kurpfalz (Lutheran 1556 and 1576–1583; Reformed 1563–1576 and from 1583) | CA, Apol, SA, catechism (1556) | BoC (1580) | BoC dropped; Heidelberg Catechism (1586, Reformed) |
| Upper Palatinate | — | Signed 1581/82 | Released 1585, Reformed; CA *variata* |
| Pfalz-Neuburg | CA, Apol, Wittenberg Concord, SA (1564/1576) | Signed | — |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken (Reformed from 1588), Sponheim | Latin subscription formula 1564 | Zweibrücken refused | Sponheim takes the FC as a "symbol" (1608) |
| Württemberg | CA, Apol, *Loci* (1547); Württemberg Confession (1552/59) | Mandate to sign 1577 | FC |
| Hohenlohe | Own corpus (1578) | Added by hand | *Gründlicher Bericht* 1603/05; FC restored 1630 |
| Swabian cities | Ravensburg local formula 1578 | Hall, Wimpfen, Lindau, Memmingen and others sign | — |
| Ansbach | Oath on the gospel (1528); Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma* 1573 | BoC in the oath (1588) | BoC "our *corpus doctrinae*" (1594) |

| Region | Before the FC | The FC and BoC | After 1580 |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nürnberg | *Norma doctrinae* 1573 | Refused | *Norma doctrinae* |
| Regensburg | CA, Apol, SA (1567) | BoC signed by every minister (1572/88) | BoC |
| Strasbourg (Moderate Reformed to 1548) | CA (1549, under the Interim); CA and Apol "*stipulata manu*" (1562); Concord 1563 | FC "*corde et manu*" (1577) | FC in the ordination question (1598) |
| Colmar (Moderate Reformed from 1578) | Oath on Scripture, Fathers, CA and Apol (1575) | Refused (1578) | — |
| Transylvania | Oath on the CA (Burzenland 1573) | — | Superintendent's oath on CA, SA and the creeds (1601) |

## 17.2 Scope, sources and method

### 17.2.1 What was searched

The whole of `eko.db` was searched for the vocabulary of confessional obligation:

- the names of the confessions, in German and Latin and with their OCR variants (*augspurgische confession*, *apologia*, *schmalkaldische artikel*, *catechismus Lutheri*, *formula concordiae*, *concordienbuch*, *corpus doctrinae*, *norma doctrinae*, *loci communes*, *repetitio*);
- the verbs of binding (*unterschreiben*, *subscribieren*, *schwören*, *geloben*, *angeloben*, *verpflichten*, *zusagen*, *Revers*, *Eid*, *Pflicht*, *iuramentum*, *subscribo*, *promitto*);
- the occasions of binding: ordination, examination, vocation, *Bestallung*, visitation, synod, admission to the consistory, and appointment as schoolmaster, superintendent or assessor.

Every hit was read in context. Each was sorted by whether it was the text of an order, Sehling's introduction or a footnote. For the laity the search covered confirmation, first communion, admission to the Supper (*exploration*, *verhör*), godparents (*gevattern*, *paten*, *susceptores*), admission as burgher (*bürger*, *hintersäß*), and oaths of councils and officials.

### 17.2.2 What the chapter does not do

- It does not give the full text of each confession, nor the history of the FC's making. It records only what the church orders themselves say.
- It does not list every signature. The great lists of subscribers in the archives are beyond the edition. Sehling sometimes reports their numbers, for example 444 signatures in Mecklenburg in 1577 (Sehling 5, pp. 142–143), and these are noted where he does.
- **A book list is not a subscription.** Many orders tell a parish to buy the CA, the *Loci* or a *Corpus doctrinae*, and tell the pastor to read it. That makes the book a standard of preaching, but it is not an oath or a signature. Where an order lists books only, this is said.
- **A territorial norm is not always a personal obligation.** A preface may say that "our churches" hold the CA without saying how a pastor was bound to it. The chapter marks which kind of statement each quotation is.

### 17.2.3 Cautions

- **Sehling's introductions and apparatus.** Several of the best statements about subscription, such as the Hildesheim decision of 1593 or the Anhalt refusal of the FC (Anhalt was still Lutheran), are found only in Sehling's introductions or footnotes, which quote or summarise archival sources. They are marked as such.
- **Apparatus variants.** Some orders were reissued, and the editors print the later wording in the apparatus. Examples are the Ansbach priest's oath (1528, with forms of 1570, 1573 and 1588), the Hohenlohe KO of 1578 (with a handwritten addition naming the FC) and the Kurpfalz KO of 1556 (with variants of 1577). These are quoted as variants with their dates.

- **Record headings.** The database's record headings sometimes name the first order in a volume section rather than the order on the page. So document 1844 is headed "Diese erste Danziger Ordnung … 1557", but its p. 234 is the Thorn KO of 1575, and its p. 210 the Danzig KO of 1612. Each order is named here from Sehling's running head. Where the running head is itself misleading, this is said (as at Anhalt, p. 579, where a passage of the 1588 *Instructio* runs onto a page headed with the next order).
- **OCR errors.** OCR errors are quoted as printed. Thus Calenberg's "Gorpus doctrinae Julium" is printed as such, and the Kassel KO of 1539 (Moderate Reformed) carries the running head "1589".

#### 17.2.4 How to read the regional sections

Each regional section goes through its orders in date order. For each it says:

- **what the norm was**: which documents the order names, in what order, and with what qualifiers ("unaltered", "as delivered in 1530", "in its true sense");
- **who was bound**: ordinands, pastors, superintendents, schoolmasters, assessors, councils;
- **how they were bound**: book list, visitation question, examination, promise, *Revers*, oath, ordination "Yea", or subscription.

The table in §17.18 gathers these by order.

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## 17.3 The documents the orders name

This glossary gives the documents in the form the orders name them. Where an order's wording identifies a particular edition or reading (the *invariata* or the *variata*, the first print of the Apology), this is noted. For dates and contents the standard editions are the *Bekenntnisschriften der evangelisch-lutherischen Kirche* (BSLK, BSELK), which the editors of the later volumes cite in their footnotes.

#### 17.3.1 The ancient creeds

- **The three creeds** (*drei Hauptsymbola*, *symbola oecumenica*): the Apostles', the Nicene and the Athanasian. They come first after Scripture in almost every list.
- **The four councils** (Nicaea, Constantinople, Ephesus and Chalcedon). These are named in Kurland (1570), the Katzenelnbogen pastors' oath (1598, Philippist, together with Leo's Tome to Flavian), Strasbourg (1598) and the Upper Palatinate (1585, Reformed). In Hessen-Kassel and the Upper Palatinate they are aimed against the ubiquity doctrine.

#### 17.3.2 The Lutheran confessions

- **Augsburg Confession (CA), 1530.** Named in nearly every order from the 1530s on. The qualifiers matter:
  - *wie anno 30 übergeben*, *ungeändert*, *unverändert*, *uralt*, *rein, unverfälscht*, *invariata*, "the first edition";
  - against "as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg" (§17.12.2) and the *variata* of 1540. Ansbach (1573) names both "the last" and "the first edition" as signed at Naumburg in 1561 (§17.14.1).
- **Apology of the CA (Apol).** Usually paired with the CA. Goslar names it "in the first print" (§17.9.6). Anhalt dates the CA and the Apology "anno 30 und 33" (§17.6.6).
- **Smalcald Articles (SA), 1537.** Often "written by Dr Luther for the council at Mantua, and subscribed at Smalcald" (Albertine Saxony 1580, Ernestine Saxony 1569).
- **Luther's Small and Large Catechisms (SC, LC).** Hoya calls them "the laymen's Bible" (§17.9.5).
- **Wittenberg Concord, 1536.** Named in Pfalz-Neuburg (1564) and in Osnabrück (1610), which calls it "*Formula Concordiae*, anno 1536 aufgerichtet". This should not be confused with the FC of 1577.
- **Formula of Concord (FC), 1577, and the Book of Concord (BoC), 1580.** The FC is also called the *Bergisches Buch*, the *einigungs und erklerungs notel* (Henneberg), the *einigungs formul* (Henneberg, Waldeck) and the *Concordibuch*. The BoC is the whole corpus printed in 1580.
- **Erfurt Apology of the BoC, 1582.** Signed with the FC in Hildesheim (§17.10.1).

#### 17.3.3 Melanchthon and the Philippist corpora

- ***Loci communes*.** Melanchthon's doctrinal handbook. It was the examination textbook in Albertine Saxony (1540), Württemberg (*Loci recentiores*, 1547), Pomerania, Nassau-Diez (1564) and Ansbach (1573).
- ***Repetitio* or *Confessio Saxonica*, 1551.** Written for the Council of Trent. Albertine Saxony (1557), Ansbach (1573) and Bremen (1570, Philippist) name it.
- ***Examen ordinandorum*** (Melanchthon's examination of ordinands, 1552) and the ***Responsiones* to the Bavarian articles**.
- ***Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (or *Misnicum*), 1560.** Melanchthon's collected doctrinal works, printed by Vögelin in Leipzig. It was official in Electoral Saxony until 1574 and was adopted in Kurland (1570), Silesia (Brieg 1592), Oldenburg (1573), Bremen (1570–1575) and Hesse (1571), both Philippist, and Pfalz-Zweibrücken.

#### 17.3.4 Territorial corpora and local confessions

- ***Corpus doctrinae Pomeranicum*** (1564): Melanchthon's works with Luther's catechisms and confession, in Low German and Latin (§17.7.4).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum*** (1567), the Prussian corpus (§17.7.2).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Thuringicum*** (1570), and the Weimar *Confutationsbuch* (1558/59) against the sects, which Ernestine Saxony made binding in 1569 (§17.6.1).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Julium*** (Wolfenbüttel, 1576), signed in Calenberg-Göttingen (§17.9.4).
- ***Corpus doctrinae Wilhelminum*** (Lüneburg, 1576). This is named only in Sehling's introduction (Sehling 6/1, pp. 487–489).
- **The Brunswick city corpus** (1571) (§17.9.2).
- **The Lüneburg Articles** (1561), against the Philippists. Rostock (1573) names them, and Brunswick (1571) condemns what they condemn.
- **The confession of Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg against the Interim** (1548). Part of the Lüneburg city corpus (1575).
- **The Lower Saxon Confession** (1571). In Goslar's corpus (1591/95).
- **The Mansfeld confession** (1565) (§17.6.3).
- **The Danzig *Notel*** (1562). The city's own formula, signed by its clergy (§17.7.3).
- **The Ansbach-Nürnberg *Norma doctrinae*** (1573) (§17.14.1).
- **The Strasbourg Concord** (1563) (§17.15).
- **The Ravensburg "formula concordiae"** (1578, renewed 1617), a local formula of the city's preachers (§17.13.5).
- **The Württemberg Confession** (*Confessio Virtembergica*), presented at Trent in 1552 (§17.13.1).
- **The Hohenlohe *Gründlicher Bericht*** (1603/05), which took the place of the FC (§17.13.3).
- **The Confessio Anhaltina** and the Anhalt Supper confession of 1585. These are named in Sehling's introduction (§17.6.6).

#### 17.3.5 Reformed documents

- **The Heidelberg Catechism** (1563, Reformed), which replaced Luther's catechism in the Reformed Kurpfalz *Bestallung* of 1586 (§17.12.1).
- **The CA as "repeated" at Frankfurt (1558) and Naumburg (1561)**: the CA read in the *variata* sense, in the Upper Palatinate (1585, Reformed) and in Bremen (the Frankfurt Recess, 1575, Philippist).
- **"The confession of the Reformed doctrine"** required for admission to the Supper in Nassau-Dillenburg (1582, Reformed) (§17.17.2).

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### 17.4 The forms of binding

The orders bind ministers to their confessions in seven ways. They range from the weakest, a list of books, to the strongest, an oath confirmed by one's own signature. Most orders use several of them at once.

1. **The book list.** The parish must buy the named books, keep them in the inventory, and the pastor must read them. Examples are Ernestine Saxony 1554, Albertine Saxony 1540 and 1557, Pomerania 1563/69 and Brieg 1592 (§§17.5.1, 17.6.1, 17.7.1, 17.7.4). It sets a standard of preaching but requires no personal act.
2. **The visitation question.** The visitor asks the pastor whether he holds the named confessions as his *norma doctrinae* and renounces all contrary opinions. Examples are Henneberg 1574, Magdeburg 1583 and Nassau-Weilburg 1576 (§§17.6.2,

17.6.4, 17.11.5).

3. **The examination.** The candidate is examined from the *Loci*, the CA or the corpus. Examples are Württemberg 1547, Strasbourg 1549 and Ansbach 1594, where he must first have read the whole BoC (§§17.13.1, 17.15.1, 17.14.1).
4. **The promise, *Revers* or *Bestallung*.** The minister promises in writing or by handshake to teach according to the named books. Examples:
   - the Nassau-Diez *Revers* (1564, §17.11.4);
   - the Pomeranian synodal formula "*per dexteram societatis*" (1574, §17.7.4);
   - the Kurpfalz *Bestallungen* "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath" (1580–1601, Lutheran in 1580 and Reformed from 1586, §17.12.1).
5. **The oath.** The minister swears by God's name to the named books. Examples:
   - Ansbach, *glob und schwer* (1528 and later, §17.14.1);
   - the Peine and Gottorp preachers' oath (1574, §§17.8.4, 17.10.1);
   - the Wimpfen *iuramentum* (after 1577, §17.13.5);
   - Colmar (1575, §17.15.3);
   - Hessen-Darmstadt (1617, §17.11.1);
   - the Transylvanian superintendent (1601, §17.16). The Hohenlohe oath of 1588 swears to the church order rather than to named confessions (§17.13.3).
6. **The ordination vow.** At the laying on of hands the ordinand is asked whether he will direct his faith and confession by the named books and answers "Yea". This is so in Henneberg 1582, Waldeck, Frankfurt 1589 and Strasbourg 1598 (§§17.6.2, 17.11.2, 17.11.3, 17.15.2). In Mecklenburg in 1552 the promise is to remain in "the pure Christian doctrine which he hath confessed in this hearing", and no book is named (§17.8.1).
7. **Subscription.** The minister signs the corpus or the FC "with his own hand". Examples:
   - Albertine Saxony 1580 (§17.5.3);
   - Brunswick 1571 (§17.9.2);
   - Regensburg 1572/88 (§17.14.3);
   - Strasbourg "*corde et manu*" 1577 (§17.15.2);
   - Hildesheim 1593 (§17.10.1);
   - Soest 1590 (§17.10.7);
   - Schwäbisch Hall 1614/15 (§17.13.5);
   - Wimpfen's *Notula subscriptionis* (§17.13.5);
   - Pfalz-Zweibrücken's Latin "*mente atque manu subscribo*" of 1564 (§17.12.4).

**Who was bound.** Pastors and preachers come first. The orders regularly add:

- deacons, chaplains and schoolmasters (Hildesheim, Kurpfalz 1601 (Reformed), Hessen-Darmstadt);
- superintendents (Wild- und Rheingrafschaft 1576, Transylvania 1601);
- consistorial presidents and assessors (Ernestine Saxony 1569, Prussia 1584, Ansbach 1594);
- professors (Hessen-Darmstadt 1617);
- in cities, the council itself (Regensburg 1572), and burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries (Hildesheim 1593).

For the laity see §17.17.

The ordination and installation rites in which the vows were taken are given in Chapter 13, §§13.10–13.11.

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## 17.5 Albertine (Electoral) Saxony

Albertine Saxony moved further than any other territory: from the CA and Melanchthon's *Loci* (1540), through the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (official from 1566 by Sehling's account, Sehling 1, pp. 124–125), to the Book of Concord. In 1580 a signature to the BoC was the condition of admission to every parish.

### 17.5.1 The CA and the *Loci* as a book list (1540, 1557)

The visitors' general instruction of 1540 tells pastors to preach nothing but what agrees with the CA and Apology, and to buy the books by which they will be measured. **Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn an die pfarrer und dorfschaften*, 1540** (Sehling 1, p. 285):

> Und letzlich nichts anders lehren, denn das der confession und apologia keiserlicher mai. zu Augspurg uberantwortet, und bevorn dem heiligen evangelio gemes ist; darzu wil von nöten sein, das sie ihnen keufen die biblien und dieselbe confession etc. locos communes d. Philip., postillam Lutheri und andere christliche reine bücher, und darinnen vleissig studiren.

And lastly let them teach nothing else than that which is agreeable to the confession and apology delivered to his imperial majesty at Augsburg, and above all to the holy gospel; whereto it will be needful that they buy for themselves the Bible and the same confession, etc., the *Loci communes* of Dr Philip, Luther's postil, and other Christian pure books, and study diligently therein.

By 1557 the parish was to buy the *Repetitio* (*Confessio Saxonica*) of 1551 with the CA. **Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557** (Sehling 1, p. 325):

> Bei den kirchen-vätern sol er anhalten, das sie von der kirchen-einkommen eine deutsche biblia, augspurgische confession, und deren obgemelte repetition, agenda, auch die deutsche locos communes erkaufen, die bei der pfarr bleiben und in das inventarium vorzeichnet werden, dieselbe sol er und der cüster fleissig zu lesen schuldig sein.

He shall urge the churchwardens that they buy out of the church's income a German Bible, the Augsburg Confession and the repetition thereof above mentioned, the agenda, and also the German *Loci communes*, which shall remain with the parish and be written into the inventory; and the same shall he and the sexton be bound diligently to read.

The norm here is wholly Melanchthonian. The CA is read with its *Repetitio* and the *Loci*; the Smalcald Articles are not named.

#### 17.5.2 The *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560–1574)

The 1560 *Corpus doctrinae* (§17.3.3) was the official norm in Electoral Saxony from 1566 until the fall of the Philippists in 1574 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 1, pp. 124–125). Outside Saxony it was named as a norm in Kurland, Silesia, Oldenburg, Bremen and Hesse, and Melanchthon's *Loci* in Nassau (§§17.7.1, 17.8.2, 17.10.4, 17.10.5, 17.11.1, 17.11.4).

#### 17.5.3 The Book of Concord as the condition of office (1580)

Elector August's church order of 1580 makes a signature to the BoC the condition of being sent to a parish. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 380):

> Wann eine person auf gehalten examen und beschehene probpredigt zum kirchendienst tüchtig erkant, und durch die kirchen ördentlich vocirt und berufen ist, auch das buch der concordien mit eigener hand unterschrieben hat, das ihm der lehr halben zutrauen, sol ihm vor endlicher abfertigung auf die verordente pfarr, durch den presidenten oder directorem des consistorii nachfolgende erinnerung mit ernst fürgehalten werden.

When a person, after the examination held and the trial sermon done, is found fit for the ministry of the church, and is orderly called and summoned by the church, and hath also subscribed the Book of Concord with his own hand, so that he may be trusted as touching doctrine, then before his final dispatch to the parish appointed the admonition following shall be earnestly set before him by the president or director of the consistory.

The same order sets out the whole norm, in the sequence that became standard. The Smalcald Articles are now in, and the *Corpus Philippicum* is gone (Sehling 1, p. 420):

> ist unser ernstlicher wille und meinung, das hinfüro in allen kirchen unserer churfürstenthumb und landen, in massen wir anfangs in der Vorrede uber diese verfaste ordnung uns erkleret, sich alle pfarrer und kirchendiener anders nicht, denn den biblischen prophetischen und apostolischen schriften und denselben nach der unverenderten confession und der darauf erfolgten apologia und den zu Schmalkalden durch d. Luthern geschriebenen und die daselbsten versandete fürneme theologen approbirten und unterschriebenen artikeln, so dem concilio zu Mantua uberantwortet werden sollen, auch beiden christlichen catechismis d. Luthers und der jüngst darauf zu Torgau von allen streitigen artikeln gestelter und hernach aus aller andern kirchen eingebrachtem bedenken verbesserter einhelliger declaration und christlichen erklerung durchaus gemess verhalten und denselben zuwider weder heimlich noch offentlich, nichts leren sollen.

It is our earnest will and meaning that henceforth in all the churches of our electorate and lands, as we declared at the beginning in the preface to this ordinance, all pastors and ministers of the church shall in all things behave themselves

according to none other than the Biblical, prophetic and apostolic Scriptures; and after them according to the unaltered confession and the apology that followed thereon; and the articles written by Dr Luther at Smalcald, approved and subscribed by the chief theologians there assembled, which were to have been delivered to the council at Mantua; and also both Christian catechisms of Dr Luther; and the unanimous declaration and Christian explanation of all the articles in controversy, lately drawn up thereupon at Torgau and afterwards amended from the judgments brought in from all other churches; and shall teach nothing contrary to the same, neither secretly nor openly.

The FC is not named by its title. It is described as the declaration made at Torgau and amended from the judgments of the other churches. The same order's teaching on confirmation is quoted in §17.17.1.

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## 17.6 Ernestine Saxony, Henneberg, the Harz counties, Magdeburg, Halberstadt and Anhalt

The Ernestine dukes were the Gnesio-Lutheran counterweight to Albertine Saxony. Their norm adds the Smalcald Articles early, and in 1569 the Weimar *Confutationsbuch* against the "sects". Around them the smaller territories of central Germany (Henneberg, Mansfeld, the archbishopric of Magdeburg, Halberstadt) followed with local confessions and, after 1577, with the FC. Anhalt alone refused it.

### 17.6.1 Ernestine Saxony: from the book list to the public confession (1554, 1569)

The 1554 instruction puts the Smalcald Articles beside the CA in the parish's library. **Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction Johans Friderichen des mittlern, Johans Wilhelm und Johans Friderichen d. j.*, 1554** (Sehling 1, p. 227):

> so sollen die visitatores mit den kirchvetern iedes orts vorfugen, das sie von dem kirchen oder anderm gemainen gut eine deutsche biblien und doctor Luthers hauspostil, Augspurgische confession, Schmalkaldische artikel, so Lutherus uf das concilium zu Mantua anno 38, zusampt der unterrichtung der visitatorn welche auch letzlich anno 38 ausgangen, kaufen, und dieselbigen erblichen zu der pfar widemen, in das pfar inventarium vorzeichen

the visitors shall order with the churchwardens of every place that they buy out of the church's or other common goods a German Bible and Doctor Luther's house postil, the Augsburg Confession, the Smalcald Articles, [which] Luther [made] for the council at Mantua in the year 38, together with the Instruction of the Visitors, which likewise came forth lastly in the year 38; and endow them in perpetuity to the parish, and write them into the parish inventory.

By 1569 no one could sit in the consistory at Jena unless he openly confessed the norm and condemned the errors named in the ducal *Confutationes* of 1558. **Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569** (Sehling 1, p. 234):

> so ist unser gemüht und meinung, und wollen das kein person daran angenommen, noch geduldet werde, die sei dann eines christlichen erbarn wandels und bekenne sich offentlich und klar zu der h. schrift, des alten und neuen testaments, den dreien symbolis, apostolico, niceno und Athanasii, der augspurgischen confession, wie die anno 30. keiser Carol dem fünften, von unserm herren grosvater, und genedigen herrn vater herzog Johansen, und herzog Johans Fridrichen zu Sachsen, churfürsten, hochlöblicher christlicher gedechtnus, und etlich andern fürsten und stedten, ubergeben, sampt deren apologia, auch den artikeln, welche durch obgenanten d. Martin Luther seliger, auf das concilium zu Mantua gestellt, […] und widersprochen dargegen allen alten und neuen secten und corruptelen, so gottes reinen wort zu wider, und sonderlich denen die in unsern fürstlichen confutationibus, nach gehabtem synodo zu Weimar im 1558. jar im druck ausgangen, begriffen sind.

it is our mind and meaning, and we will, that no person be received thereto nor suffered, except he be of a Christian and honest conversation, and confess himself openly and clearly to the holy Scripture of the Old and New Testaments; to the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; to the Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered in the year 30 to the emperor Charles the Fifth by our lord grandfather and gracious lord father, Duke John and Duke John Frederick of Saxony, electors of most laudable Christian memory, and certain other princes and cities; together with the apology thereof; and also to the articles which the aforenamed Dr Martin Luther of blessed memory set forth for the council at Mantua […]; and except he gainsay all old and new sects and corruptions which are contrary to God's pure word, and especially those that are comprehended in our princely confutations, which came forth in print after the synod held at Weimar in the year 1558.

This is the first order in this chapter to make a **negative** confession part of the obligation. The minister must not only hold the books but condemn, by name, the errors a particular book condemns. Brunswick (1571, §17.9.2), Regensburg (1567, §17.14.3) and Hessen-Darmstadt (1617, §17.11.1) do the same. In 1580 the Ernestine pastors were told to read the coming Book of Concord, on which they would be examined (Sehling 1, p. 254).

#### 17.6.2 Henneberg: the visitation question, subscription and the ordination vow (1574–1582)

The Henneberg visitation of 1574/77 asks every pastor whether he holds the confessions as his *norma doctrinae*. **Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung*, 1574, 1577** (Sehling 2, p. 291):

> Jedes orts pfarrherr ist erstlich zu befragen, ob sich derselbe mit seinem glauben, lehr und bekäntniss zu h. göttl. schrift, den drei haupt symbolis, augspurgischer confession, apologia, schmalkaldischen artikeln und catechismo Lutheri durchaus in ihrem rechten, natürlichen, klaren verstande gelassen beipflicht, und pro norma doctrinae halten, auch dabei beständig verharren, hingegen aber alle widrigen meinungen absagen wolle.

The pastor of every place is first to be asked whether he, with his faith, doctrine and confession, assenteth wholly to the holy divine Scripture, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism, in their right, natural and plain sense, and will hold them *pro norma doctrinae* and continue steadfastly therein, and on the other hand renounce all contrary opinions.

The church order of 1582 recalls that Henneberg's ministers had always been "appointed, examined, ordained and made to subscribe" on these books, and lately also on the FC. **Henneberg, *Des durchlauchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Georg Ernsten, kirchen ordnung*, 1582** (Sehling 2, p. 300):

> solche bücher und schriften jederzeit fur unserer kirchen normam gehalten, unsere kirchendiener auch darauf bestellen, examiniren, ordiniren, und unterschreiben lassen, […] wie wir uns denn auch, sampt den kirchendienern unserer fürstlichen grafschaft, hiebevor neulich auf eben dieselbige normam in unterschreibung der gemeinen einungs und erklerungs notel, sonsten die formula concordiae genant, als die aus solchem grund hergeflossen, gleichsfals referiret und gezogen.

[we have] at all times held such books and writings for the norm of our churches, and have also caused our ministers of the church to be appointed, examined, ordained, and to subscribe thereupon […]; as we also, together with the ministers of the church of our princely county, have lately referred and drawn ourselves likewise to this same norm in the subscription of the common note of union and declaration, otherwise called the Formula of Concord, as that which hath flowed from the same ground.

The same order puts the whole norm, the FC included, into the ordination itself. The ordinand answers "Yea" before hands are laid on him (Sehling 2, p. 324):

> Wollet ihr nu, wie euch nach lenge aus gottes wort vorgehalten, auch in demselbigen euch in euerm ampt weiter mass gegeben, halten, besonders aber euren glauben und bekentnus richten nach gottes wort, wie dasselbige in prophetischer und apostolischer heiliger schrift verfasset, desgleichen nach den dreien haupt symbolis, auch hieraus hergenomener, wolgegründter, warer augspurgischen confession, apologia, schmalkaldischen artikeln, kleinem und grossem catechismo Lutheri, sampt jetziger christlichen einigungs formul, so saget es hiermit gott und seiner heiligen christlichen kirchen, auch uns von ampts wegen, zu. Antwort: Ja. So befehlen wir euch das ampt des heiligen evangeliums, in dem namen gottes des vaters, sons, und heiligen geistes, amen. Imponite manus.

Will ye now keep that which hath been set before you at length out of God's word, and the further measure given you therein for your office; but especially direct your faith and confession according to God's word, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic holy Scripture, and likewise according to the three chief creeds, and the true, well-grounded Augsburg Confession taken therefrom, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, together with the present Christian formula of union? Then promise it hereby to God and his holy Christian church, and to us by virtue of our office. Answer: Yea. So we commit unto you the office of the holy gospel, in the name of God the Father, the Son and the Holy Ghost, amen. *Lay on hands.*

Waldeck copied this question word for word (§17.11.2).

### 17.6.3 Mansfeld: the county's own confession of 1565 and the Book of Concord (1580, 1586)

Mansfeld's corpus included its own confession of 1565. **Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda für die prediger der grafschaft Mansfeld*, 1580** (Sehling 2, p. 215):

> Was aber gleichwol die lere anlanget, so bezeugen wir auch hiemit kürzlich und offentlich, das wir durch gottes gnade bei der waren und richtigen einhelligkeit der rechtgleubigen christlichen kirchen gottes bestendiglich verharren, wie dieselbige in gottes des allmechtigen unwandelbaren worte der heiligen schrift, als in den büchern der heiligen propheten und aposteln, in den allgemeinen symbolis apostolico, Athanasiano, und Niceno, in der ersten reinen, unverenderten augspurgischen confession, wie die anno 1530. weiland keiser Carolo dem fünften etc. zu Augspurg ubergeben, derselben apologia, in den schmalkaldischen artikeln, den beiden catechismis, grossen und kleinen, und in den andern schriften des teuren mannes gottes Lutheri, auch in unsern, in offenem druck, sonderlich des 1565. jars, ausgegangenen bekentnissen, begriffen und verfasset ist.

But as touching doctrine, we testify also hereby briefly and openly that by God's grace we continue steadfastly in the true and right unanimity of the orthodox Christian church of God, as the same is comprehended and set down in the unchangeable word of Almighty God, the holy Scripture, that is, in the books of the holy prophets and apostles; in the universal creeds, the Apostolic, the Athanasian and the Nicene; in the first, pure, unaltered Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered at Augsburg in the year 1530 to the late emperor Charles the Fifth, etc.; in the Apology thereof; in the Smalcald Articles; in the two catechisms, the Large and the Small; and in the other writings of the dear man of God, Luther; and also in our confessions that have come forth in open print, especially those of the year 1565.

The consistory order of 1586 then sets the BoC beside the county's own confession as the rule by which disputes are decided. **Mansfeld, *Gräflich mansfeldische geistliche consistorial ordnung*, 1586** (Sehling 2, p. 201):

> so soll derselbige aus der h. bibel, den schriften der propheten und aposteln, aus den symbolis und erkäntnüssen der wahren kirchen, aus der augspurgischenconfession und apologia, aus d. Luthers schriften und catechismis, aus unserer kirchen anno 1565 ausgegangenen bekäntnüss geortert und entschieden werden. Weil auch das anno 1585 in druck ausgegangene concordien buch jeztgedachter und erzehlter norma einstimmet, und wir dasselbige in allen unsern kirchen durch die ganze grafschaft haben deponiren, niederlegen und den pfarr herren darnach zu lehren befehlen lassen,

then shall the same be discussed and decided out of the holy Bible, the writings of the prophets and apostles, out of the creeds and confessions of the true church, out of the Augsburg Confession and Apology, out of Dr Luther's writings and catechisms, [and] out of our church's confession that came forth in the year 1565. And forasmuch as the Book of Concord that came forth in print in the year 1585 [variant: 1580] agreeth with this norm just now named and recounted, and we have caused the same to be deposited and laid up in all our churches throughout the whole county, and the pastors to be commanded to teach thereafter,

The consistory was to admit no one who "will not be at one with the others" in this norm.

### 17.6.4 Archbishopric of Magdeburg: the visitation question (1583)

The archbishopric's visitation instruction of 1583 calls the confessions "the right *corpus doctrinae*", and makes the FC rest on them. **Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583** (Sehling 2, p. 419):

> Welche gemeine offentliche schriften und confessiones neben den prophetischen und apostolischen schriften und den dreien haupt symbolis das rechte corpus doctrinae, das ist summarischer inhalt, furbilt und richtschnur der reinen lehr sei, ob er seine lehr in allen seinen offentlichen predigten, auch in bericht bei den schwachgleubigen und kranken, vormuge prophetischer und apostolischer schriften, den dreien haupt symbolis, der augspurgischen unvorenderten confession, welche Carolo quinto anno etc. 30 ubergeben, derselben apologia, schmalkaldischen artikeln, grossen und kleinen catechismos Lutheri, darauf sich die anno etc. 80 publicirte formula concordiae grundet, fur sich selbst halte und gleube und seiner bevohlenen kirchen vortrage und lehre.

Which common public writings and confessions, beside the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures and the three chief creeds, are the right *corpus doctrinae*, that is, the summary content, pattern and rule of pure doctrine. Whether he himself holdeth and believeth, and propoundeth and teacheth to the church committed to him, his doctrine in all his public sermons, and also in

instructing the weak in faith and the sick, according to the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, the three chief creeds, the unaltered Augsburg Confession which was delivered to Charles the Fifth in the year 30, the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, and Luther's Large and Small Catechisms, upon which the Formula of Concord published in the year 80 is grounded.

#### 17.6.5 Halberstadt: the Brunswick corpus (1588)

Halberstadt, ruled by the Wolfenbüttel dukes as administrators, takes over the *Corpus doctrinae* printed in the Brunswick church order. **Bishopric of Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588** (Sehling 2, pp. 468–469):

> darneben die biblia, augsburgische confession, derselben apologia, schmalkaldische articul, catechismos Lutheri, wie auch das corpus doctrinae in der braunschweigischen kirchen ordnung nicht allein fleissig zu lesen und in kopf zu fassen, sondern auch nach derselben richtschnur und regul ihre predigten anzustellen,

and besides, not only diligently to read and get into their heads the Bible, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, and also the *corpus doctrinae* in the Brunswick church order, but also to order their sermons according to the rule and line thereof.

#### 17.6.6 Anhalt: the refusal

Anhalt never signed the FC. By Sehling's account, Prince Joachim Ernst "could not be moved" to sign it. From 1578 Anhalt's ordinands were no longer sent to Wittenberg but ordained at Zerbst (Sehling 2, pp. 525, 528–529). After his death the visitation instruction of 1588 still named a norm without the FC. It dates the CA and the Apology "anno 30 und 33" and names the late Prince Wolfgang's signature to them. **Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis der vorgenommenen Visitation*, 21 September 1588** (Sehling 2, p. 579, a page that bears the running head of the next order):

> damit sie einige normam haben christlicher lehre und bekenntnüss, thun wir ihnen darzu folgende bücher benennen, als die heilige biblia des alten und neuen testaments, die drei haupt symbola, apostolicum, Nicaenum et Athanasianum, die augspurgische confession und derselben apologia, wie die anno 30 und 33 heiser Carln den fünften allerhochlöblichster, christlicher gedächtnüss übergeben und in offenen druck ausgangen, welche auch weiland der hochgeborne fürst herr Wolfgang, fürst zu Anhalt etc. hochlöblicher christseligster gedächtnüss etc. unser geliebter vater mit eigener hand neben andern chur und fürsten und ständen unterschrieben, die schmalkaldischen artikul von d. Martino Luthero anno 37 verfertiget, und itzt gemeldes herren doctoris klein und grossen catechismos, welches sie pro confessione und norma sanctorum verborum halten und dabei in christlicher einfalt bleiben,

that they may have one norm of Christian doctrine and confession, we name to them for that purpose the following books: namely the holy Bible of the Old and New Testaments; the three chief creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as they were delivered in the years 30 and 33 to the emperor Charles the Fifth of most laudable Christian memory, and came forth in open print, which also the late high-born prince, Lord Wolfgang, prince of Anhalt, etc., of most laudable and blessed Christian memory, etc., subscribed with his own hand beside other electors, princes and estates; the Smalcald Articles made by Dr Martin Luther in the year 37; and the said doctor's Small and Large Catechisms; which they shall hold *pro confessione* and as the norm of sound words, and abide therein in Christian simplicity.

The canon here is that of the 1570s, before the FC: CA, Apol, SA and the catechisms. It is held "*pro confessione*", not signed.

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### 17.7 Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania

The eastern territories kept to the norms they had made before the FC. Brieg in Silesia still named the *Corpus Philippicum* in 1592. Prussia had its own *Corpus doctrinae* of 1567. The cities of Royal Prussia had a corpus confirmed by the Polish king, and Danzig a city formula, the *Notel*. Pomerania had a Melanchthonian corpus of its own. None of the orders quoted here makes the FC a condition of office, and Danzig forbade it to be "canonised".

#### 17.7.1 Silesia: Brieg (1592)

The Brieg church order of 1592 names, beside the CA and Apology, Luther's writings, the *Corpus doctrinae Philippi* and the Mecklenburg agenda. **Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592** (Sehling 3, pp. 444–445):

> Die lehre betreffend: Soll diese rein ohne irrige meinung, wie sie in den prophetischen und apostolischen schriften und approbirten symbolis, deren grund und inhalt in der Augspurgischen confession und ihrer apologia, den scriptis Lutheri, corpore doctrinae Philippi, der Mecklenburg, agenda, und was hiemit stimmet, begriffen, geführet und wie viel der zeit gepflanzet werden,

Touching doctrine: this shall be carried on pure, without erroneous opinion, as it is comprehended in the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures and the approved creeds, whose ground and content [is set down] in the Augsburg Confession and its Apology, in the writings of Luther, the *corpus doctrinae* of Philip, the Mecklenburg agenda, and whatsoever agreeth herewith; and [so shall it be] planted, so far as the time [alloweth].

A later chapter of the same order, headed *De corpore doctrinae*, tells every preacher what to read. The database files this page under the next territory, Jägerndorf, but it is the end of the Brieg order (Sehling 3, p. 448):

> De corpore doctrinae. Es soll ein jeder praedicant in städten und dörfern neben der Heil, bibel haben und fleissig lesen das Corpus doctrinae Philippi Melanchtonis, die postillen des herrn Lutheri, die Thomos Lutheri und Philippi, auch anderer gelehrter leute fügliche scripta.

*Of the corpus doctrinae.* Every preacher in towns and villages shall have, beside the holy Bible, and diligently read, the *Corpus doctrinae* of Philip Melanchthon, the postils of Master Luther, the Tomes of Luther and of Philip, and also the fitting writings of other learned men.

This is a book list, not a subscription.

#### 17.7.2 Ducal Prussia: the *Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* (1567) and the assessors' oath (1584)

Prussia's corpus of 1567 was made after the Osiandrian controversy. Pastors are to keep strictly to it. **Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568** (Sehling 4, p. 111):

> Darinnen sollen sie gestracks bleiben bei dem Corpore Doctrinae, wie dasselbige in diesem fürstenthumb anno 1567 aus den prophetischen und apostolischen schriften, den alten symbolis, auch der lehre Lutheri zusamen getragen und publiziret ist, und sollen sie sonderlich den heiligen catechismum Lutheri gar fleissig dem volk einbilden.

Therein they shall abide strictly by the *Corpus doctrinae*, as the same was gathered together and published in this duchy in the year 1567 out of the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, the ancient creeds, and also the doctrine of Luther; and they shall especially imprint the holy catechism of Luther very diligently upon the people.

The consistory order of 1584 binds its president and assessors by oath to "our church's unanimous Christian confession", without naming its parts. **Prussia, *Consistorialordnung*, 1584** (Sehling 4, p. 125):

> Eid des präsidenten und der assessorum. Ich schwöre, dass ich in allen und jeden dieses konsistorii vorfallenden sachen, beneben den andern hiezu verordneten assessorn, getreulich und fleissig nach meinem besten verstand und vermögen rathen, bedenken, suchen und befördern helfen wolle, was dem seelig machenden göttlichen worte, unserer kirche einhelligen christlichen bekenntniss, der ehrbarkeit, und beschriebenen rechten gemäss,

*Oath of the president and of the assessors.* I swear that in all and every matter coming before this consistory I will, together with the other assessors appointed thereto, faithfully and diligently, according to my best understanding and ability, counsel, consider, seek and help to further that which is agreeable to the saving divine word, to our church's unanimous Christian confession, to honesty, and to the written laws,

#### 17.7.3 Thorn, Elbing and Danzig: a royal corpus and the city *Notel* (1575, 1586, 1612)

The three great cities of Royal Prussia needed the king's leave for their religion. Thorn's church order names the corpus that King Sigismund Augustus had allowed them: Luther's two catechisms and the CA, "given both to teachers and hearers". **Thorn, *Kirchenordnung für Thorn*, 1575** (Sehling 4, p. 234):

> Darumb gedachte obrickeit fur nützlich und nöthig geachtet, ihren kirchen ein gewisses corpus doctrinae, aus den schriften der h. propheten und aposteln zusammengetragen, furzulegen, nemlich den kleinen und grossen catechismum Lutheri und die confessionem Augustanam, welche auch Sigismundus Augustus, könig in Polen, hochlöbl. und seel.

> gedächtniss, allergnädigster herr den dreien städten Thorn, Elbing und Dantzig auf ihr demütiges und emsiges ansuchen allergnädigst erlaubet und zugelassen hat, darumb auch beide den lehrern und zuhörern mitgegeben worden, über gedachtem corpore doctrinae vest zuhalten und nichts daran zuendern,

Therefore the said magistrates have held it profitable and needful to set before their churches a certain *corpus doctrinae*, gathered out of the writings of the holy prophets and apostles, namely Luther's Small and Large Catechism and the Augsburg Confession; which also Sigismund Augustus, king of Poland, of most laudable and blessed memory, [our] most gracious lord, most graciously permitted and allowed to the three cities of Thorn, Elbing and Danzig upon their humble and earnest suit; wherefore it hath also been given both to the teachers and to the hearers, to hold fast by the said *corpus doctrinae* and to change nothing therein.

Danzig had besides its own formula, the *Notel* of 1562, signed by its clergy. By Sehling's account it remained the city's confessional basis until 1793 (Sehling 4, p. 172). When the FC came, the council forbade it. **Danzig, *Decret des Senats*, 23 October 1586** (Sehling 4, p. 192):

> sich keiner art und form zu reden gebrauchen sollen, die wieder die augspurgische confession und notel streiten. Des sollen auch weder publice noch privatim des Calvini, Zwinglii schriften, das concordienbuch und dergleichen buecher, von imands der herrn predicanten canonisiret oder imgeringsten defendiret, vielweniger irkeinerley streitschriften von ihnen in dieser stadt oder kirchen eingefueret werden.

[they] shall use no manner nor form of speech that striveth against the Augsburg Confession and the *Notel*. Neither shall the writings of Calvin [or] Zwingli, the Book of Concord and the like books be canonised, or in the least defended, by any of the lords preachers, either publicly or privately; much less shall any controversial writings whatsoever be brought by them into this city or church.

The Book of Concord is here set beside Calvin and Zwingli as a party book. In 1612 the norm was still the CA of 1530 and the *Notel*, which each preacher had signed. **Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612** (Sehling 4, p. 210):

> Dieser vier predicanten lehr und predigtampt belangend, seind sie semptlich pflichtschuldig, ihrer bestellung nach bei der einmal erkannten und bekanten wahrheit gotlichs worts nach inhalt. der prophetischen und apostolischen schriften, der einmal von den protestierenden stenden keiser Carole quinto anno 1530 zu Augspurg übergebenen confession, und der von ihnen selbst unterschriebenen der stadt formula concordiae oder notel zu lehren zu predigen und die hochwürdigen sacramenta zu administrieren.

As touching the doctrine and preaching office of these four preachers, they are all bound in duty, according to their appointment, to teach, to preach and to administer the most worthy sacraments according to the truth of God's word once known and confessed, after the content of the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, of the confession delivered once for all by the protesting estates to the emperor Charles the Fifth at Augsburg in the year 1530, and of the city's formula of concord or *Notel*, subscribed by themselves.

Here "formula concordiae" means Danzig's own *Notel*, not the FC of 1577.

#### 17.7.4 Pomerania: the Melanchthonian corpus (1563/69) and the synodal handshake (1574)

The Pomeranian order refers its churches to Luther's writings and to Melanchthon's *Loci* and Apology. It requires every parish to buy the book in which Melanchthon's works are printed "together with the catechisms and confession of Luther", the *Corpus doctrinae Pomeranicum*. **Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569** (Sehling 4, p. 382):

> Dise unde andere artikel der christlicken lere schölen in den kercken unser lande rein unde vlitich geleret unde mer erkleret werden, in dem vorstande, darin se hen unde wedder van doctore Martino Luthero in sinen schritten, unde van Philippo Melanthone in den locis communibus unde in der apologien der augsborgischen confession utgelecht unde vorvatet sint, darup de pamerischen kercken sick refereren unde to merer declaration erbeden. Unde dewile dorch den ehrwerdigen Philippum Melanthonem de vörnemesten artickel unser waren christliken lere des evangelii mit raht Martini Lutheri seligen unde anderer vörnemen theologen in etlicke böker ganz richtich, godtsalich unde christlick begrepen unde vorvatet, ock allrede tovörn in ein boeck samt den catechismis unde confession Lutheri, up unsen bevel unde vorordeninge tosamende gedrücket sind, willen, ordenen unde gebeden wi hir mit, dat in einer iedern parkercken in

> unsen landen, in steden effte dörpern, vörgedachte böke, […] schölen geköfft unde vorwaret unde van den kerckendenern vlitich gelesen werden.

These and other articles of Christian doctrine shall be purely and diligently taught in the churches of our lands, and further explained, in the sense in which they are expounded and set down here and there by Doctor Martin Luther in his writings, and by Philip Melanchthon in the *Loci communes* and in the Apology of the Augsburg Confession; whereunto the Pomeranian churches refer themselves, and offer [themselves] to further declaration. And forasmuch as the chief articles of our true Christian doctrine of the gospel have been comprehended and set down by the reverend Philip Melanchthon, with the counsel of Martin Luther of blessed memory and other chief theologians, in certain books, very rightly, godly and Christianly, and have already before been printed together into one book, together with the catechisms and confession of Luther, at our command and ordinance: we will, ordain and command herewith that in every parish church in our lands, in towns or villages, the aforesaid books […] shall be bought and kept, and diligently read by the ministers of the church.

The personal bond came at the synod, by a handshake modelled on Galatians 2:9. The minister promises obedience to the superintendent and synod "in retaining the godly consensus of heavenly doctrine". No confession is named. **Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574** (Sehling 4, p. 492):

> Formula, Obedientiae et fidelitatis pastorum et omnium ministrorum ecclesiae, praestanda in synodo, data dextera societatis, qua et apostoli inter se sunt usi. Gal. 2. vers. 9. Ego N. N. promitto, per dexteram societatis, obedientiam et fidelitatem reverendo superintendenti nostro, et venerabili synodo N. in retinendo pio consensu doctrinae coelestis, in toto ministerio rite peragendo, in regendis moribus vitae, in tuenda conjunctione et concordia, et in rebus omnibus, juxta statuta synodi, ordinationem ecclesiasticam et agendam. Quae omnia fideliter bona […] conscientia praestabo, pro posse et nosse, et falsus frater non ero,

*Form of the obedience and fidelity of the pastors and all ministers of the church, to be performed in the synod, the right hand of fellowship being given, which the apostles also used among themselves, Gal. 2, verse 9.* I, N. N., promise by the right hand of fellowship obedience and fidelity to our reverend superintendent and to the venerable synod of N., in retaining the godly consensus of heavenly doctrine, in rightly performing the whole ministry, in governing the manners of life, in maintaining union and concord, and in all things according to the statutes of the synod, the church order and the agenda. All which I will perform faithfully with a good […] conscience, as far as I am able and know, and will not be a false brother.

Pomerania never adopted the FC as such. By Sehling's account a ducal mandate of 10 May 1593 accepted only "the synodal decision in three chief points out of the *Formula Concordiae* against the Calvinists" (Sehling 4, p. 321).

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## 17.8 Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Schleswig-Holstein

The Baltic territories show the widest spread of all:

- **Mecklenburg** signed the FC in 1577.
- **Kurland** bound its preachers to the Wittenberg *Corpus Philippicum* in 1570.
- **Lauenburg** (1585) named the FC as an alternative ("or").
- **Gottorp**, under the Danish king's lead, rejected the Concord. It bound its preachers by oath to the CA, Apology, SA and catechisms in 1574, and then in 1607 to Scripture alone.

### 17.8.1 Mecklenburg and Rostock (1552, 1573)

Mecklenburg's church order of 1552 was the work of Melanchthon's circle, and its examination was Melanchthon's *Examen ordinandorum*. The ordinand's promise names no book. He promises to remain in the doctrine he has just confessed in his examination. **Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552** (Sehling 5, p. 192):

> Nach dieser vermanung sol eine christliche zusage von im genomen werden. Nemlich, das er in diesem heiligen amt, mit gottes furcht, glauben und anrufung zu gott dienen wolle, und wolle züchtiglich leben und vleissig lernen. Item, das er in der reinen christlichen lere, die er in dieser verhör bekant hat, und die durch gottes gnad in diesen kirchen eintrechtiglich geprediget wird, mit gottes hülf bestendig bleiben wolle, und wolle im amt treue und vleissig sein. Darauf spricht der ordinandus, er wolle durch gottes gnad dieses treulich thun und halten.

After this admonition a Christian promise shall be taken of him: namely, that he will serve God in this holy office with the fear of God, with faith and calling upon God, and will live soberly and learn diligently. Item, that he will by God's help abide steadfastly in the pure Christian doctrine which he hath confessed in this hearing, and which by God's grace is preached with one accord in these churches, and will be faithful and diligent in the office. Whereupon the ordinand saith that by God's grace he will faithfully do and keep this.

Twenty years later the Rostock ministerium wrote a full list into its statutes. It includes the Mecklenburg church order, the Lüneburg Articles of 1561 against the Philippists, and the FC, "which they approved by their subscription in 1577". **Rostock, *Statuta et decreta*, 1573** (Sehling 5, p. 285):

> I. Ut amplectatur sanam incorruptamque doctrinam caelestem, traditam in scriptis prophetarum apostolorum et evangelistarum, in ea sententia quae expressa est in symbolis, in confessione Augustae exhibita Carolo V. imperatori anno M. D. XXX. ejusque apologia, in Smalcaldicis articulis, in libro legum ceremonialium hujus ducatus, ut vocant, megapolensis, in catechismis majori et minori, caeterisque divini Lutheri scriptis omnibus, in articulis Luneburgensibus et in libro concordiae seu consensionis inter docentes in ecclesiis doctrinam caelestem a doct. Martino Luthero instauratam amplectentibus, quem anno M. D. LXXVII. (sed leges conditae an. 73) subscriptione sua comprobarunt.

I. That he embrace the sound and uncorrupt heavenly doctrine delivered in the writings of the prophets, apostles and evangelists, in that sense which is expressed in the creeds; in the confession exhibited at Augsburg to the emperor Charles V in the year 1530, and the apology thereof; in the Smalcald Articles; in the book of the ceremonial laws of this duchy, the Mecklenburg [book], as they call it; in the Large and Small Catechisms, and all the other writings of the divine Luther; in the Lüneburg Articles; and in the book of concord or agreement among those who teach in the churches and embrace the heavenly doctrine restored by Doctor Martin Luther, which in the year 1577 they approved by their subscription (but the laws were made in the year 73).

The editor's parenthesis shows that the FC was added to a statute of 1573. By Sehling's account, 444 Mecklenburg ministers signed the FC in 1577 (Sehling 5, pp. 142–143).

#### 17.8.2 Kurland: the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae* (1570)

Kurland's church order of 1570 binds its new preachers to the CA and Apology, the creeds, the "oldest, unfalsified councils", the SA and "the whole Wittenberg *corpus doctrinae*" of 1560. **Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570** (Sehling 5, p. 70):

> Wenn nun die neuen prediger also introducirt und zum lehramte bestetiget worden seind, sollen sie sich höchstes vermügens befleissigen, das allein seligmachende wort gottes, biblischer, das ist prophetischer und apostolischer schrift, den rechten verstand des gesetzes und evangelii, nach der Augspurgischen confession und apologia, woran wir nicht zweifeln, sonder die gewissheit haben, das sie die rechte, einige und warhaftige lehre der prophetischen und apostolischen zeugnusse sei, der dreien Symbolen, eltisten, unvorfelschten concilien, Schmalkaldischen artickeln und dem ganzen Wittenbergischen corpore doctrinae von dem seligen herrn Philippo Melanthone anno 1560 vice cygneae cantionis in den druck verfertigt, ihrer gemeine, vermüge derselbigen richtigen lehr auf Christi bevelich ohne scheu fürhalten,

When now the new preachers have been thus introduced and confirmed in the office of teaching, they shall endeavour to the utmost of their power to set before their congregation without fear, at Christ's command and according to the right doctrine thereof, the only saving word of God of the Biblical, that is, of the prophetic and apostolic Scripture, [and] the right understanding of the law and the gospel; according to the Augsburg Confession and Apology (whereof we doubt not, but have the certainty, that it is the right, only and true doctrine of the prophetic and apostolic testimony), the three creeds, the oldest unfalsified councils, the Smalcald Articles, and the whole Wittenberg *corpus doctrinae* made ready for the press by the late Master Philip Melanchthon in the year 1560, in the stead of a swan-song.

The Philippist corpus stands here beside the Smalcald Articles, a combination that the FC party would not allow after 1574.

#### 17.8.3 Lauenburg: the FC as an alternative (1585)

Lauenburg's church order of 1585 makes each pastor promise to teach according to the creeds, the "ancient and unaltered" CA, the Apology, the SA, Luther's writings and catechisms, "or the *formula concordiae*, touching the points of doctrine in dispute". **Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585** (Sehling 5, p. 402):

> Zum andern, dass er nichts, denn was gott in seinem heiligen beschriebenen worte der bibel offenbart hat, lehren und predigen solle, nach erklerunge der dreien vorgenanten symbolorum ecclesiae, der uhralten und ungeanderten Augspurgischen confession, apologia, schmalcaldischen artikeln, der schriften D. Martini Lutheri und cathechismi gross und kleins, oder formulae concordiae, belangend die streitige lehr puncta, und derwegen diese bücher fleissigen und alle tage durchsehe, evolvire, und ihm bekandt mache,

Secondly, that he shall teach and preach nothing but what God hath revealed in his holy written word of the Bible, according to the explanation of the three aforenamed creeds of the church, the ancient and unaltered Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, the writings of Dr Martin Luther, and the Large and Small Catechism, or the *formula concordiae* as touching the points of doctrine in dispute; and that he therefore diligently look through these books every day, turn them over, and make himself acquainted with them.

The FC is not a further book in a list. It is the authorised explanation of the older books where they are disputed.

#### 17.8.4 Schleswig-Holstein (Gottorp): an oath instead of the Concord (1574, 1607)

The Danish king and the dukes in Schleswig-Holstein would not take the Torgau Book or the Bergen Book. By Sehling's account, the Gottorp theologians asked instead for a new edition of the *Corpus Philippicum*, with the SA and Luther's catechisms added (Sehling 23, p. 298). Instead of the Concord, Superintendent Paul von Eitzen drew up a preacher's oath against the Calvinists, centred on the Lord's Supper (Sehling 23, p. 309). **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid*, 1574** (Sehling 23, p. 365; Low German):

> gelieck wo dusse lehre vam hochwerdigen sacrament is erkleret in der Augsborgischen Confession, Apologia, Schmalkaldischen Artickelen und beiden Catechismis des hilligen lehrers und vaders Martini Lutheri, welchers böker, schriffte und bekentnisse ick ock in dussem artickel holde und gelöve recht und warhafftig. Und by dussem minem ede vorplichte my, dorch de hulpe und gnade Gottes, desulve wäre, einfoldige lehre vam hilligen aventmahl miner befahlen gemeine getruwliken, unvorfelschet und unverändert vorthoholden und tho leren beth an minen ende.

even as this doctrine of the most worthy sacrament is declared in the Augsburg Confession, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms of the holy teacher and father Martin Luther; which books, writings and confessions I also hold and believe in this article to be right and true. And by this my oath I bind myself, through the help and grace of God, faithfully to set forth and to teach the same true and simple doctrine of the holy Supper to the congregation committed to me, unfalsified and unaltered, until my end.

The same oath was used in the duke's pledged district of Peine, in the bishopric of Hildesheim (§17.10.1).

In 1607 Duke Johann Adolf abolished the oath and put a new one in its place. **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides*, 4 January 1607** (Sehling 23, p. 415):

> Nachdem wir aus hochwichtigen, bewegenden uhrsachen den bißhero in gebrauch gehaltenen priester eydt verendern lassen, wie ihr aus anliegender formul zu vornehmen, also, daß nun hinfortan nach dieser neuen eydt formul die ordinanden den priesterlichen eidt schwehren und der vorige eyd cassiret unnd auffgehoben seyn soll,

Forasmuch as we, for very weighty and moving causes, have caused the priest's oath hitherto held in use to be altered, as ye may perceive from the form enclosed, so that henceforth the ordinands shall swear the priestly oath after this new form of oath, and the former oath shall be cassated and abolished,

The new oath names no confession at all, only "the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures". **Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid*, 4 January 1607** (Sehling 23, p. 416):

> Ich, N.N., schwere zu Gott, daß ich mein anbefohlen Lehrambt mit hbgsten Trewen und gepuerenten Eiver ahne fleischliche Adfecten fhuren, das lauter, reine Wortt Gottes unvervelscht, wie solches in den Prophetischen unnd Apostolischen Schrifften begriffen, ohne menschliche, verfuhrische Anhenge und Opinion lehren unnd predigen,

I, N.N., swear to God that I will conduct the office of teaching committed to me with the highest faithfulness and due zeal, without carnal affections; [and] teach and preach the clear, pure word of God unfalsified, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic Scriptures, without human, seductive additions and opinions;

The change from 1574 to 1607 is the plainest case in the corpus of a confessional oath being withdrawn. A Lutheran oath against the Calvinists gave way to a Scripture-only oath under a prince of Reformed sympathies.

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## 17.9 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, Lüneburg, Calenberg-Göttingen, Hoya and Goslar

Lower Saxony was the home ground of Chemnitz and Mörlin. It produced the most precise statements of the norm: the CA understood "as explained" by the Apology, the SA and Luther's catechism. It also produced the densest set of local corpora:

- the Lüneburg Articles of 1561;
- the Brunswick city corpus of 1571;
- the Lower Saxon Confession of 1571;
- the Wolfenbüttel *Corpus Julium* and the Lüneburg *Corpus Wilhelminum*, both of 1576.

Subscription to the corpus was the condition of admission in the cities as well as in the duchies.

### 17.9.1 Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechism (1569)

Duke Julius's church order of 1569 defines the *corpus doctrinae* and adds a "declaration" to shut out those who shelter under the name of the CA. **Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569** (Sehling 6/1, pp. 91–92):

> So ist nun diß die summa, daß das corpus doctrinae, die form und das fürbild der reinen lehr, wie dieselbig in den kirchen dieses fürstenthumbs hinfuro geprediget und gelehret soll werden, sein soll die heilige, prophetische und apostolische schrift in dem einfeltigen, wahren, eigentlichen, gesunden verstand, wie die schrift sich selbs erkleret, und wie derselbig verstand auß und nach Gottes wort kurzlich zusammengezogen ist in den alten, bewehreten symbolis apostolico, nicaeno, athanasiano und in den artickeln der augspürgischen confession. Weil aber auch leider in diesen letzten betrübten zeiten der welt etliche rotten und sekten ihre corruptelas unter dem nahmen der augspürgischen confession zu bedecken und zu beschönen sich understehen […] muß diese declaration deutlich dabey gesetzt werden, das wir die augspürgische confession annhemen, verstehen und behalten in dem verstand, wie sie in der erfolgten und angeheften apologia, nachmals in den schmalkaldischen artickeln und entlich im catechismo und andern schriften Lutheri auß Gottes wort expliciert und verkleret worden ist.

This then is the sum: that the *corpus doctrinae*, the form and pattern of pure doctrine, as the same shall henceforth be preached and taught in the churches of this principality, shall be the holy, prophetic and apostolic Scripture, in the simple, true, proper and sound sense, as Scripture expoundeth itself, and as the same sense is briefly drawn together out of and according to God's word in the ancient approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and in the articles of the Augsburg Confession. But forasmuch as, alas, in these last troubled times of the world certain factions and sects take upon them to cover and colour their corruptions under the name of the Augsburg Confession […], this declaration must be plainly set thereby: that we accept, understand and hold the Augsburg Confession in the sense in which it hath been expounded and declared out of God's word in the Apology that followed and is annexed thereto, afterwards in the Smalcald Articles, and lastly in the catechism and other writings of Luther.

The editors' footnote at "the name of the Augsburg Confession" points to the *variata* of 1540. This formula, the CA read through the Apology, the SA and the catechism, was taken up almost word for word in Verden in 1606 (§17.10.2). It is also the rule by which the FC itself reads the CA.

### 17.9.2 Brunswick city: articles to be subscribed (1571)

The city of Brunswick's ministerium put to every new minister a set of Latin articles for subscription. They name the city's *corpus doctrinae* and condemn whatever the Lüneburg Articles condemn. **Brunswick, *Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis qui ad ministerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur*, 1571** (Sehling 6/1, p. 471):

> Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis qui ad ministerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur. […] Formam purae doctrinae et sanorum verborum sicut in scriptis propheticis et apostolicis et probatis symbolis explicata et in confessione augustana et apologia eiusdem sicut anno 1530 exhibita et anno 1531 edita sunt atque in articulis schmalcaldicis et catechismis Lutheri declarata sunt fideliter et constanter nobiscum profiteatur et retineat. Hoc enim est corpus doctrinae huius ecclesiae. § 2. Corruptelas cum hoc corpore doctrinae pugnantes sive olim damnatae sive recens exortae sint sive

> imposterum oriantur non amplectatur nec spargat sed fugiat et damnet praecipue vero quae in articulis lyneburgicis damnatae sunt.

Articles which are set forth to be subscribed by those who are received into the ministry in this church. […] [§ 1.] That he faithfully and constantly profess and retain with us the form of pure doctrine and of sound words, as it is set forth in the prophetic and apostolic writings and the approved creeds, and in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as they were exhibited in the year 1530 and published in the year 1531, and as it is declared in the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechisms. For this is the *corpus doctrinae* of this church. § 2. That he embrace not nor spread the corruptions that fight with this *corpus doctrinae*, whether they were condemned of old or have lately arisen or shall arise hereafter, but flee and condemn them; and especially those that are condemned in the Lüneburg Articles.

The city's order for calling preachers, of the same year, sets the subscription in the procedure. The new man subscribes and vows before he is admitted to the "colloquy", the city's assembly of ministers. **Brunswick, *Vokationsordnung für die Prediger*, 1571** (Sehling 6/1, p. 457):

> Zum siebenden: Wen nach diesem allen die vocatio volzogen, so soll die angenommen person durch einen erbaren rath und kastenherren des weichbildes dem colloquio presentiert und darselbst mit ihme gehandelt werden, das ehr dem corpori doctrinae dieser loblichen kirchen unterschreibe und angelobe, das ehr sich der wolhergebrachten christlichen ordnunge des colloquii uhterwerfe, alsdan soli ehr vor ein membrum des colloquii auf und angenommen werden.

Seventhly: when after all this the call hath been completed, the person accepted shall be presented to the colloquy by an honourable council and the treasurers of the ward, and there it shall be dealt with him that he subscribe the *corpus doctrinae* of this laudable church, and vow that he will submit himself to the well-established Christian order of the colloquy; and then shall he be received and accepted as a member of the colloquy.

By Sehling's account, the city council later sided against the duke over the signing of the FC (Sehling 6/1, p. 341).

#### 17.9.3 Lüneburg: the duchy's confession (1564) and the city's corpus (1575)

The Lüneburg church order of 1564 states the duchy's doctrine as a confession of the prince, in its preface. It names the creeds, Luther's catechism, and the CA and Apology of 1530. **Principality of Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564** (Sehling 6/1, p. 534):

> sondern wir bekennen, das wir die lere vorrecht halten, die in unserm fürstenthumb geprediget wird, die Gott selbs hat durch seinen Son Jhesum Christum geoffenbaret und die in der propheten und aposteln schrift gefasset in dem verstande, der in den symbolis apostolico, niceno und Athanasii, auch in D. Martini Lutheri seliger catechismo, auch in der confession und apologia, welche der römi. kei. maj. zu Augspurg anno etc. 1530 uberantwortet, verfasset und erholet ist. Und gedenken, bey solcher erkanten lere mit göttlicher hülf bestendig zu bleiben,

but we confess that we hold for right the doctrine that is preached in our principality, which God himself hath revealed through his Son Jesus Christ, and which is contained in the writings of the prophets and apostles, in the sense that is set down and repeated in the creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, and also in the catechism of Dr Martin Luther of blessed memory, and also in the confession and apology which were delivered to the Roman imperial majesty at Augsburg in the year 1530. And we purpose by God's help to abide steadfastly by such acknowledged doctrine.

The city of Lüneburg had its own corpus. Besides the usual books it held the confession of Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg against the Interim of 1548. Each ordinand had to write his own confession, which was examined against it. **Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575** (Sehling 6/1, p. 654):

> so befhelt ehr ihnen ihre bekantnus von den vornembsten und nottwendigsten artickeln der kirchenlehre, die da mit den schriften der heiligen propheten, Christi und der apostolen mit den dreyen symbolis apostolico, niceno und Athanassi, mit der confession, so rö[mische] kay[serliche] ma[]este]tt Carolo V. anno etc. 30 auf dem reichstage zu Augspurg von etlichen des heiligen römischen reichs stenden ubergeben, sampt der apologia, so kurz darauf gestellet, mit den smalchaldischen artickeln, catechismis Lutheri und dieser dreyer erbaren stette Lubeck, Hamburg und Luneburg bekantnusse, so anno 1548 wider das interim im druck ausgangen, welche scripta vor das corpus oder fundamentum doctrinae huius ecclesiae gehalten werden, durchaus ubereinstimme, mit dem furderligsten schriftlich zu vorfassende und uberantwortende.

then he [the superintendent] commandeth them with all speed to set down in writing and deliver their confession of the chiefest and most necessary articles of the church's doctrine, which [must] agree throughout with the writings of the holy prophets, of Christ and of the apostles; with the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; with the confession which was delivered in the year 30 by certain estates of the holy Roman Empire to the Roman imperial majesty Charles V at the diet at Augsburg, together with the Apology that was set forth shortly after; with the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechisms, and the confession of these three honourable cities, Lübeck, Hamburg and Lüneburg, which came forth in print in the year 1548 against the Interim; which writings are held for the corpus or foundation of the doctrine of this church.

In 1576 the duchy received Chemnitz's *Corpus doctrinae Wilhelminum*. By Sehling's account it was still signed with the church order of 1643 (Sehling 6/1, pp. 487–489).

#### 17.9.4 Calenberg-Göttingen: the *Corpus Julium* (1601) and Göttingen's own order (1568)

When the Wolfenbüttel dukes inherited Calenberg-Göttingen, its four great towns came under their corpus. A preacher presented for a town where the duke was patron had to subscribe the ducal church order and the *Corpus doctrinae Julium*, and then the town's own church order. **Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied*, 1601** (Sehling 6/2, p. 894):

> auch, wann die praesentirte person in lehr und leben genugsamb qualificirt befunden und die fürstliche kirchenordnunge und Gorpus doctrinae Julium unterschrieben, sol dieselbige person dem rath und ministerio alda zur probpredigt, und da die vocatio aus erheblichen ursachen nicht abgeschlagen wirdet, zugleich zur immission und subscription ihrer sonderbaren vor vielen jahren aufgerichteten kirchenordnunge,

and when the person presented hath been found sufficiently qualified in doctrine and life, and hath subscribed the princely church order and the *Corpus doctrinae Julium*, the same person shall be sent over to the council and ministry there for the trial sermon, and, if the call be not refused for weighty causes, at the same time for induction and for subscription of their particular church order set up many years ago.

Göttingen's own order had made the norm in 1568. It runs: the CA of 1530, the Apology, the SA, Luther's catechism and "our old church order of the city of Göttingen, reviewed and approved by Luther". **Göttingen, *Christliche und in Gottes wort … gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen*, 1568** (Sehling 6/2, p. 916):

> daß man, wie in annemung des evangelii, anno 30 allhie auß Gottes genediger heymsuchung geschehen, auch forthin gedenke einhelliglich und einfeltiglich zu bleiben bey der rechten augspurgischen confession, wie dieselbige anno 30 der rhömischen keyserlichen majestat von protestierenden stenden uberantwortet, auch eiusdem apologia, schmalkaldischen artickeln, catechismo Lutheri und der alten von Luthero ubersehener und approbierter unser, der stadt Göttingen, kirchenordnung, wie dieselbige gründlichen genommen auß den schriften der propheten und aposteln und in Lutheri büchern weiter erkleret werden, und alles, das denselbigen entgegen, es habe namen, wie es wölle, es komme her, von wem es wölle, solle verworfen werden,

that, as was done here in the year 30 at the receiving of the gospel through God's gracious visitation, so henceforth also [they] purpose to abide with one accord and in simplicity by the right Augsburg Confession, as the same was delivered in the year 30 by the protesting estates to the Roman imperial majesty, and by the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism, and our old church order of the city of Göttingen, reviewed and approved by Luther, as the same are grounded thoroughly on the writings of the prophets and apostles and further explained in Luther's books; and that all that is contrary to the same, be its name what it will, and come it from whom it will, shall be rejected.

#### 17.9.5 Hoya: the FC in the church order (1581)

The county of Hoya's church order of 1581 sets the FC at the end of the list. It calls Luther's catechisms "the laymen's Bible". **Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581** (Sehling 6/2, p. 1131):

> das sie in allen ihren predigten und Lehren durchaus den prophetischen und apostolischen schriften altes und neues testaments, den dreyen allgemeinen heuptsymbolen, als dem apostolico, nicaeno und athanasiano, der reinen, ungeenderten augspurgischen confession, so keyser Carolo dem V. zu Augspurg anno 30 in der grossen reichsversamlung ubergeben, sampt derselben apologia und articulen zu Schmalkalden, anno 37 gestellet, und von den fürnembsten theologen damals unterschrieben worden, den catechismis, grossen und kleinen, des herrn D. Martini Lutheri, als der leyen bibel, darinnen alLes kurz begriffen, was in heiliger schrift weitleuftig gehandelt und einem fromen,

> gottseligen Christen zu seiner seligkeit zu wissen von nöten ist, und auch der formulae concordiae, das ist, der christlichen, wiederholten, einmütigen bekentnis der churfürsten, fürsten und stende augspurgischer confession, anno 80 voilzogen und publiciert, sich sollen gleichförmig und einhellig gemeß verhaiten.

that in all their sermons and teachings they shall behave themselves throughout conformably and with one accord according to the prophetic and apostolic writings of the Old and New Testaments; the three universal chief creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; the pure, unaltered Augsburg Confession, which was delivered to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg in the year 30 in the great diet of the empire, together with the Apology thereof, and the Articles set forth at Smalcald in the year 37 and subscribed at that time by the chief theologians; the catechisms, Large and Small, of Master Dr Martin Luther, as the laymen's Bible, wherein is briefly comprehended all that is handled at large in holy Scripture, and is needful for a godly, devout Christian to know for his salvation; and also the *formula concordiae*, that is, the Christian, repeated, unanimous confession of the electors, princes and estates of the Augsburg Confession, completed and published in the year 80.

The order goes on to threaten anyone found not to hold by "these writings, as the right rule … the only touchstone".

#### 17.9.6 Goslar: a city corpus signed "with our own hands" (1591/95)

The imperial city of Goslar adopted its corpus on 9 November 1591 and signed the list in 1595. The list is notable for three things:

- it names the Apology "as it first came forth in print";
- it includes the Lower Saxon Confession of 1571 "in its right Saxon sense";
- it holds the FC "in its right Saxon sense" as signed by the council and ministry in 1577.

No minister or schoolmaster is to be admitted unless he has signed. **Goslar, *Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften*, 11 May 1595** (Sehling 7/2.2, pp. 339–340):

> Wir, ein gantzes ministerium der kirchen und gemeinde Gottes der kayserlichen freyen reiches stadt Gosslar, thun kund und bekennen mit dieser unser eigen unterschrifft, das wir im jar nach Christi, unsers herrn, seligen geburt 1591, am 9. tage Novembris, in beysein unser christlichen obergkeit, […] diese nachfolgende bucher, schriffte und bekentnisse zu einem Corpore doctrinae auffund angenomen haben, […] Zum funfften bekennen wir uns auch zu der Apologia derselbigen Auspurgischen Confession, wie sie zum ersten mal im druck ist ausgangen. […] Zum siebenden bekennen wir uns auch zu der Sechsischen Kirchen Confession in irem rechten Sechsischen verstande, wie sie anno Christi 1571 einhelliglich mit der Sechsischen kirchen subscription und unterschrifft in den druck gegeben worden. […] Zum achten halten wir uns auch stet und feste an die Formulam concordiae unser evangelischen kirchen in irem rechten Sechsischen verstande, wie sie auff- und angenomen, auch eintregtiglich unterschrieben ist worden, insonderheit auch von einem ehrbaren rath und ministerio alhie zu Goslar anno Christi 1577. […] Es sol auch in kunfftiger zeit niemand zu einem ministro ecclesiae oder schueldiener auff- und angenomen oder darinnen geduldet werden, er habe den so wol alse wir diesem itzt genanten, unserm Corpori doctrinae sich mit eigener hand unterschrieben, […] Zu mehrer uhrkund der warheit haben wir uns mit eigenen hemden unterschrieben.

We, the whole ministry of the church and congregation of God of the imperial free city of Goslar, do make known and confess with this our own subscription that in the year after the blessed birth of Christ our Lord 1591, on the 9th day of November, in the presence of our Christian magistrates […], we accepted and received these books, writings and confessions following for a *corpus doctrinae*, […] Fifthly, we confess ourselves also to the Apology of the same Augsburg Confession, as it came forth in print the first time. […] Seventhly, we confess ourselves also to the Confession of the Saxon Churches in its right Saxon sense, as it was given to the press in the year of Christ 1571 with one accord, with the subscription and signature of the Saxon churches. […] Eighthly, we hold ourselves also steadfastly and firmly to the *Formula concordiae* of our evangelical churches in its right Saxon sense, as it hath been received and accepted, and also subscribed with one accord, and especially also by an honourable council and ministry here at Goslar in the year of Christ 1577. […] Neither shall anyone in time to come be received and accepted as a minister of the church or schoolmaster, or be suffered therein, unless he, as well as we, have subscribed this our *corpus doctrinae* now named with his own hand, […] For the greater witness of the truth we have subscribed with our own hands.

"*hemden*" ("shirts") is the OCR's reading of *henden*, "hands".

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## 17.10 Hildesheim, Verden, Osnabrück, Oldenburg, Bremen, East Frisia and Soest

The north-west was confessionally divided. The Lutheran cities and counties (Hildesheim, Verden, Osnabrück, Oldenburg, Soest) held to the FC, or reached it late. Bremen went over to the Philippist and then the Reformed side. East Frisia settled its quarrel in 1599 by naming nothing but "the Augsburg Confession".

### 17.10.1 Hildesheim: the Peine oath (1574/89) and the subscription of the city's officials (1593)

The ducal oath used in Gottorp (§17.8.4) was also used in Peine, a district of the bishopric of Hildesheim held in pledge by the dukes of Schleswig-Holstein. It is printed here in High German, sworn "by the holy name of God". The first two articles bind to Scripture and the creeds and are aimed at the Calvinist Christology. **Peine, *Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina*, [1574/89]** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 787):

> 1. Ich N. prediger des h. evangelii, ordentlicherweise durch den willen Gottes geeschet und berufen, schwere bei dem h. namen Gotteß und meines erlösers Jesu Christi, daß ich die göttliche, biblische schrift in allen punkten, artikeln und worten halte und gläube warhaftig.
> 2. Zum anderen, daß ich auch daß h. apostolische symbolum und die anderen waren symbola, so von der h. allgemeinen christl. kirchen seind approbiret und angenomen, halte und geläube warhaftig in allen artikeln unseres christlichen glaubenß nach dem richtschnur göttliches wortß und also auch in dem artikel von der unzertrenlichen vereinigung der zweien naturen, göttlicher und menschlicher, in der einigen ungeteileten person Christi, welche unzertrenliche vereinigung keine zeit noch stunde in ewigkeit kan auflosen oder teilen.

1. I, N., preacher of the holy gospel, orderly called and summoned by the will of God, swear by the holy name of God and of my Redeemer Jesus Christ that I hold and believe the divine, Biblical Scripture to be true in all points, articles and words.
   2. Secondly, that I also hold and believe the holy Apostolic Creed and the other true creeds, which have been approved and received by the holy universal Christian church, to be true in all articles of our Christian faith according to the rule of God's word; and so also in the article of the inseparable union of the two natures, divine and human, in the one undivided person of Christ, which inseparable union no time nor hour can dissolve or divide in eternity.

Its third and fourth articles go on to the CA with the Apology, the SA and the catechisms, and to the Lord's Supper "as declared in the Augsburg Confession, Apology, Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 788).

The city of Hildesheim had signed the FC on 10 April 1580 (Sehling's apparatus, Sehling 7/2.1, p. 909). In 1593 its government extended the subscription to the city's lay officials. The council's decision is known only from Sehling's introduction, which quotes it from the council's records. **Hildesheim, council decision on the subscription of the *Formula Concordiae*, 30 August 1593, quoted in Sehling's introduction** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 817):

> Als am 18. Junii neigst verschienen die lobliche sambtregierunge dero stadt Hildesheim sich einhellich beraten, das der herr superintendens, die hern burgermeister, syndici, physici, secretarien, wie auch alle prediger und schuldiener beider stette die Formulam Concordiae und deren Apologiam mit ihrer subscription corroboriren solten, so ist demnach sollicher radtschlag erneuert und nochmalig von der loblichen regierunge geschlossen, das von ihnen und ihren successorn allermassen, wie der her superintendens den anfank gemacht, ein jeder ohne allen anhank zu sollicher Formula Concordiae und deren Apologia mit eigner hand sich bekennen und dieselbe unterschreiben solle. Actum den 30. Augusti anno etc. 93.

Whereas on the 18th of June last past the laudable joint government of the city of Hildesheim took counsel with one accord that the lord superintendent, the lords burgomasters, the syndics, the physicians, the secretaries, and also all preachers and schoolmasters of both towns should confirm the *Formula Concordiae* and the Apology thereof with their subscription; therefore the said resolution hath been renewed and once more concluded by the laudable government: that by them and their successors, every one without any reservation, even as the lord superintendent hath made the beginning, shall confess himself to the said *Formula Concordiae* and the Apology thereof with his own hand, and subscribe the same. Done the 30th of August in the year, etc., 93.

The "Apology" is the Erfurt Apology of the BoC (1582). Sehling adds that the last signature under the Hildesheim Concord dates from 1824. The city's school order binds every teacher in the same way. **Hildesheim, *Schulordnung*, 1574/1618** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 909):

> Und weil zu dem ende die Formula Concordiae zusampt derselben Apologij bei unß angenommen, so sollen alle unser collegen nicht allein zur subscription solcher bucher verknupft und verbun[den]

And forasmuch as to that end the *Formula Concordiae*, together with the Apology thereof, hath been received among us, all our colleagues shall not only be tied and bound to the subscription of such books,

#### 17.10.2 Verden: the CA "in the sense" of the Apology, the SA and the catechisms (1606)

The Verden church order of 1606 takes over the Wolfenbüttel "declaration" of 1569 (§17.9.1) almost word for word. **Bishopric of Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606** (Sehling 7/1, p. 149):

> so soll und muß dabey die declaration in acht genomen werden, das wir die Augßburgische Confession und derselben lehr und inhalt annehmen und behalten in dem verstand, wie sie in der darauf erfolgeten Apologia und dan ferner in den Smalcaldischen Articulen und endlich im Grossen und Kleinen Catechismo Lutheri und andern büchern und schriften dieses teuren und werden mannes Gottes außgeleget und erkläret worden.

then shall and must the declaration be observed therewith: that we accept and hold the Augsburg Confession and the doctrine and content thereof in the sense in which it hath been expounded and explained in the Apology that followed thereon, and further in the Smalcald Articles, and lastly in the Large and Small Catechism of Luther, and the other books and writings of this dear and worthy man of God.

#### 17.10.3 Osnabrück: the Wittenberg Concord and the Book of Concord (1610)

The city of Osnabrück's ordinance for its superintendent and preachers names, between the Apology and the SA, "the *Formula Concordiae* set up in the year 1536", that is, the Wittenberg Concord on the Supper. It ends with the Book of Concord. **Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung*, 1610** (Sehling 7/1, pp. 296–297):

> Daß sie nemblich und furirst in ihren pfarkirchen reyne und gesunde lehre führen nach dem corpore doctrinae alter, unveranderter Außpurgischer Confession, wie die der römischen kay[serlich]en may[este]tt Carolo quinto, hochsähligsten angedenkens, ufm reichstage zu Außpurgh anno tausentfunfhundertunddreißig uberreicht worden, dazu wir und unser gemaind unß bekennen, in dem verstand, wie sie in der darauf erfolgten Apologia, item Formula Concordiae, anno 1536 aufgerichtet, wie auch denn Smalkaldischen Articulen und im Großen und Kleinen Catechismo Lutheri, dan auch in Libro Concordiae oder christlichen wiederholeten einmutigen bekentnuß der weltlichen chur-, fursten und stette außgelägt und erkleret worden.

That namely and first of all they conduct pure and sound doctrine in their parish churches according to the *corpus doctrinae* of the old, unaltered Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered at the diet at Augsburg in the year fifteen hundred and thirty to the Roman imperial majesty Charles the Fifth, of most blessed memory, whereunto we and our congregation confess ourselves; in the sense in which it hath been expounded and explained in the Apology that followed thereon, item [in] the *Formula Concordiae* set up in the year 1536, as also in the Smalcald Articles and in Luther's Large and Small Catechism, and also in the Book of Concord, or the Christian repeated unanimous confession of the secular electors, princes and cities.

The confession here is made by the council ("we and our congregation"). The duty is laid on the preachers.

#### 17.10.4 Oldenburg: the *Corpus Philippicum* (1573), then the FC (1586–1609)

Oldenburg's church order of 1573 adds to the Lutheran confessions the books "inserted and incorporated" in Melanchthon's *Corpus doctrinae*. **Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573** (Sehling 7/2.1, pp. 987–988):

> Die ganze christliche lere ist und heist gesetz und evangelium, vorfasset in den biblischen, prophetischen und apostolischen schriften, die wir nennen das Alte und Neue Testament, derer kurze summa und begriff stehet in den dreien symbolis: Apostolico, Niceno et Athanasiano, und in den artikeln der Augspurgischen Confession und derselben Apologia, Smalcaldischen Artikeln, Catechismus Lutheri und darauf erfolgten und angeheften büchern, so dem Corpori Doctrinae, vom herrn Philippo seligen geschrieben, inseriert und einverleibet seind, als da sind die repetition der Augsspurgischen Confession, Loci communes, Examen der ordinanden und widerlegung der papistischen bairischen artikel. Diese lehr und bücher sollen die pastores selbst wissen und haben und nach denselben die christliche lere dem volk verstendlich, ordentlich und ungefelscht fürtragen

The whole Christian doctrine is and is called law and gospel, set down in the Biblical, prophetic and apostolic writings which we call the Old and New Testament, whereof the short sum and compass standeth in the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; and in the articles of the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism, and the books following thereon and annexed, which are inserted and incorporated in the *Corpus doctrinae* written by Master Philip of blessed memory, such as are the repetition of the Augsburg Confession, the *Loci communes*, the Examination of the Ordinands, and the refutation of the papistical Bavarian articles. This doctrine and these books shall the pastors themselves know and have, and according to them set forth the Christian doctrine to the people understandably, orderly and unfalsified.

The FC came in by way of the *Bestallungen*, the letters of appointment. Sehling's apparatus quotes them:

- 1574 (Hamelmann): Scripture, the CA, the catechism and the church order.
- 1586 (Johannes Judex): adds the FC.
- 1608 (Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter): the full later norm, with a clause against the Calvinists. **Oldenburg, *Bestallung* of Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter, 1608, quoted in Sehling's apparatus** (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 964):

> Gottes heiliges seligmachentes wort nach den biblischen schrieften Alten und Neuen Testaments, darauf gegrundten, unverfalschten im jahr 1530 auf dem großen reichstage zue Auspurgh kaiser Carln dem funften uberreichten und der Formulae Concordiae einverleibten Auspurgischen Confession, denen darauf erfolgten Schmalkaldischen Articuln, dem Großen und Kleinen Catechismo Lutheri, der Formulae Concordiae und unßer kirchenordnung rein und lauter ohne einige corruptelen lehren,

[that he shall] teach God's holy saving word purely and clearly, without any corruptions, according to the Biblical writings of the Old and New Testaments, the Augsburg Confession grounded thereon, unfalsified, delivered in the year 1530 at the great diet at Augsburg to the emperor Charles the Fifth and incorporated in the *Formula Concordiae*, the Smalcald Articles that followed thereon, Luther's Large and Small Catechism, the *Formula Concordiae*, and our church order,

The phrase "the CA … incorporated in the FC" identifies the *invariata* by the text printed in the BoC. The visitation articles of 1609 ask each pastor to confess the FC and the church order and to "condemn the Calvinist doctrine of election, of the person of the Lord Christ and of the most worthy sacraments" (Sehling 7/2.1, p. 1175).

#### 17.10.5 Bremen: the *Corpus Philippicum* and the road to the Reformed (1570–1575)

The Bremen texts of these years are Philippist orders; the city's Reformed orders begin in 1582.

Bremen's ministerium (Philippist) agreed in 1572 on a "simple confession", by which all future ministers were to be bound. It names Scripture, the creeds, the CA and the *Corpus doctrinae* of Melanchthon, "which the Electoral Saxon and other churches have received". **Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre*, 1572** (Philippist; Sehling 7/2.2, p. 548):

> sind wir auff folgende einfältige bekändtnuß (darnach sich auch alle kirchendiener, so noch hinforder anzunehmen sein, umb jetztgedachten uhrsachen willen zu verhalten hetten) einig worden: Alß daß wir für allen dingen uns zur heiligen schrifft und hernach zu den christlichen Symbolen, Augustana confessione und dem Corpore doctrinae christianae Philippi Melanthonis (so die churfurstliche Sachsische und andere kirchen angenommen und im rechten verstande nach Gottes wort sich darauff beruffen) bekennet haben und noch bekennen. Ja, daß wir auch dem Vehrdischen abscheide, so weit derselbige neben dem Corpore doctrinae mit Gottes wort richtig und gleichformig übereinstimmet […]

we have agreed upon the following simple confession (whereby all ministers of the church who are yet to be received hereafter should also have to govern themselves, for the causes now mentioned): namely, that above all things we have confessed and do still confess ourselves to the holy Scripture, and after it to the Christian creeds, the *Augustana confessio*, and the *Corpus doctrinae christianae* of Philip Melanchthon (which the Electoral Saxon and other churches have received, and appeal thereto in its right sense according to God's word). Yea, that we also [hold] to the Verden recess, so far as the same, together with the *Corpus doctrinae*, agreeth rightly and conformably with God's word […]

The call of Markus Mening in 1570 adds the Apology and the *Confessio Saxonica* (Sehling 7/2.2, p. 544). The settlement of 1575 adds the Frankfurt Recess of 1558 (p. 566). None of these Bremen texts names the SA. This is the Philippist canon, and from it the city went over to the Reformed confession.

### 17.10.6 East Frisia: "the Augsburg Confession" and nothing more (1593, 1599)

In East Frisia, Lutheran and Reformed congregations lived side by side. Count Edzard II's church order for Marienhafe (1593) is fully Lutheran. It names the "unfalsified" CA and Apology, the catechisms "as the laymen's Bible" and the FC of 1580, in words close to Hoya's (§17.9.5). **East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung*, 1593** (Sehling 7/1, p. 684):

> so wollen wir allen unsern pastorn, predigern und kirchendienern ernstlich hiemyt aufehrlegt und bevolen haben, das sie yn allen ihren predigten, religionshandel und -gesprech durchaus den prophetischen und apostohschen geschriften, yn der heiligen bibel verfasst, sampt den dreien symbolis: Apostolico, Nicaeno et Athanasii, der ungevalschten Auspurgischen Confession und derselben Apologia, den catecismus, großen und kleinen, Lutheri (als der leyen bibel) und der Formulae Concordiae, anno 1580 wiederholet, volzogen und gepublicieret, sich gleichformich und einhellich gemaes verhalten sollen etc.

so we will that it be earnestly laid upon and commanded hereby to all our pastors, preachers and ministers of the church, that in all their sermons, religious dealings and conversations they behave themselves throughout conformably and with one accord according to the prophetic and apostolic writings set down in the holy Bible, together with the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; the unfalsified Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof; Luther's catechisms, Large and Small (as the laymen's Bible); and the *Formula Concordiae*, repeated, completed and published in the year 1580, etc.

The treaty between the count and the estates in 1599, a Reformed–Lutheran treaty, named only the CA. The editors' footnote at this point discusses the *variata*. The treaty goes on to admit that, from the beginning of the Reformation, both "opinions" about the CA's sense had been preached and suffered in the land (Sehling 7/1, p. 422). **East Frisia, *Die Konkordaten*, 1599** (Reformed–Lutheran treaty; Sehling 7/1, p. 421):

> daß in unserm lande, kirchen und schuelen, keine andere lehre dem volke solle offentlich vorgetragen, beschutzet oder gehandhabet werden, alß welche den prophetißchen und apostolißchen schriften gemeß, in die christliche bekentnuß der Augspurgißchen Confession zusamengetragen und vorfaßet

that in our land, churches and schools no other doctrine shall be publicly set before the people, defended or maintained, than that which, agreeably to the prophetic and apostolic writings, is gathered together and set down in the Christian confession of the Augsburg Confession.

### 17.10.7 Soest: "our *corpus doctrinae*", subscribed before admission (1590)

The preachers of Soest agreed on articles in 1590, "without whose subscription no one shall henceforth be admitted into our ministry". The first article lists the corpus on which they had themselves been examined and ordained. **Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590** (Sehling 22, p. 480):

> ohn wellicher articul subscription hinfurder niemandt in unnser ministerium soll zugelassen werden, unnd sindt die articule diese nachfolgende: 1. Unnser corpus doctrinae ist unnd soll sein die heilige bibel, prophetische unnd apostolische schrifft, die drey bewehrten symbola, als Apostolicum, Nicenum unnd Athanasii, die Augspurgische Confession unnd derselben Apologia, wie dieselbige anno funffzehenhundert unnd dreissigk rom. key. majestet ist uberandtwortet worden, die Schmalkaldischen Articul, der kleine unnd grosse catechismus Lutheri unnd Formula Concordiae, auff wellichs corpus doctrinae wir examinirt, ordinirt unnd in das heilige predigampt getreten sein, dabey wir auch biß in unnsere gruben vormittelst gottlicher hulff wollen bestendig beharren.

without the subscription of which articles no one shall henceforth be admitted into our ministry; and the articles are these following: 1. Our *corpus doctrinae* is and shall be the holy Bible, the prophetic and apostolic Scripture; the three approved creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's; the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, as the same was delivered in the year fifteen hundred and thirty to the Roman imperial majesty; the Smalcald Articles; the Small and Large Catechism of Luther; and the *Formula Concordiae*: upon which *corpus doctrinae* we have been examined and ordained and have entered into the holy preaching office, and whereby we will also abide steadfastly unto our graves, by means of God's help.

Soest was biconfessional in other respects. In 1583 it admitted godparents of both religions (§17.17.4).

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## 17.11 Hesse, Waldeck, Frankfurt, Nassau and Ysenburg

By the editors' account the Hessian landgraves (Philippist) together rejected the FC (Sehling 8, p. 344; Sehling 9, p. 33), although the introduction to Hessen-Darmstadt speaks of Darmstadt's signature in 1577 (Sehling 9, p. 45). After Philip's death (1567) its general synods held to the CA, the Apology, the SA, Luther's catechism and the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae*. The Agende of 1574 called the CA "the symbol of this our time". Once the landgraviate was divided, the two halves went separate ways. Hessen-Kassel bound its pastors by oath against the ubiquity doctrine (1598) and turned Reformed. Hessen-Darmstadt made every minister, professor and schoolmaster swear to the unaltered CA and renounce the Calvinists (1617). The neighbouring counties show the same spread:

- **Waldeck** took the FC into its ordination question.
- **Frankfurt** took the Book of Concord into its ordination question.
- **Nassau** went from Melanchthon's *Loci* to an explicitly Reformed order (Dillenburg 1582).
- **Nassau-Weilburg and Ysenburg** held to the unaltered CA.

#### 17.11.1 Hesse: the synod, the Agende, and the divided landgraviate (1571–1617)

The general synod's *Abschied* of 1571 (Philippist) records the pastors' undertaking to teach according to a mixed norm: the SA beside the Wittenberg *Corpus doctrinae*. **Hesse, *Abschied* of the general synod, 1571** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 355):

> und nicht allein vor sich selbst nach der heiligen gottlichen geschrift und darein begrundten dreien symbolis, der Augspurgischen Confession, daruf gevolgter Apologien, Schmalkaldischen Articulis, dem catechismo Lutheri und zu Wittenberg ausgangenem corpore doctrinae zu lehren, sondern auch eußersten vleiß dahin zu arbeiten, urbutig und von herzen willig, daß von andern, beide in schulen und kirchen, dergleichen beschehe,

[they declared themselves] ready and willing from the heart not only themselves to teach according to the holy divine Scripture and the three creeds grounded therein, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology following thereon, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's catechism and the *corpus doctrinae* that came forth at Wittenberg, but also to labour with the utmost diligence that the like be done by others, both in schools and in churches.

The Agende of 1574 (Philippist) puts Scripture alone as the *norma iudicii*, with the creeds and the CA as "the symbol of this our time". One witness of the text (B) adds the Apology and the *Corpus doctrinae* of "P. M." (Philip Melanchthon). **Hesse, *Agende*, 1574** (Philippist; Sehling 8, p. 415):

> so söllen in allen und jeden punkten christlicher lehr die prophetischen und apostolische schriften das rechte fundament, die einige norma iudicii, regel und richtschnur sein, nach welcher alle fürfallende streit und irrung dirimirt und hingelegt werden mögen, und nechst der heiligen göttlichen schrift die drei bewerte symbola Apostolicum, Nicenum und Athanasianum, dergleichen die Augspurgische Confession, dieser unser zeit symbolum, als die in den prophetischen und apostolischen schriften warhaftig fundirt und gegründet und zum eigentlichen und notwendigen bericht von einem jeden artikel gnugsam seind,

then in all and every point of Christian doctrine the prophetic and apostolic writings shall be the right foundation, the only *norma iudicii*, rule and line, according to which all controversies and errors arising may be decided and laid aside; and next to the holy divine Scripture the three approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and likewise the Augsburg Confession, the symbol of this our time, as being truly founded and grounded in the prophetic and apostolic writings and sufficient for proper and needful instruction concerning every article.

After the division, the pastors of the Lower County of Katzenelnbogen, under Hessen-Kassel (still Philippist in 1598), swore a service oath with a long Christological section. It names the four councils and Leo's Tome alongside the CA, the Apology, the SA and the Hessian synodal *Abschiede*, and it rejects the "newly introduced bodily ubiquity". **Hessen-Kassel, *Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen*, 20 February 1598** (Philippist; Sehling 9, p. 54):

> In sonderheit aber bekennen wir uns mit mund und hertzen zu der reinen lehr von der person unsers hernn Jesu Christi und mit namen dero newlich eingeführter leiblicher ubiquitet und allenthalbenheit halben zu dem claren wort Gottes, non stolide, sed dextre intellecto, den dreien hauptsymbolis Apostolico, Niceno, Athanasiano, desgleichen denen vier in der kirchen Gottes approbirten heuptconciliis und sonderlich dem concilio Chalcedonense undt der epistola Leonis ad Flavianum wie auch Augustana Confessione, deren Apologia und […] Schmalcaldicis Articulis und darauff erfolgten Synodalabschieden etc. und wollen in crafft deren auch bei den gewönlichen reden bleiben

But in especial we confess ourselves with mouth and heart to the pure doctrine of the person of our Lord Jesus Christ, and namely, as touching the newly introduced bodily ubiquity and omnipresence, to the plain word of God, understood not stupidly but rightly; to the three chief creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian; likewise to the four chief councils approved in the church of God, and especially to the council of Chalcedon and the epistle of Leo to Flavian; as also to the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, and [...] the Smalcald Articles, and the synodal recesses that followed thereon, etc.; and will by virtue of the same abide also by the customary forms of speech

The oath goes on to reject, as "monstrous and portentous propositions", the teaching that Christ's humanity is "almighty, all-knowing, infinite and everywhere present".

Hessen-Darmstadt, which stayed Lutheran, answered with a mandate that made the unaltered CA a sworn condition of office. It also required a negative declaration against every other confession. **Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana*, 28 July 1617** (Sehling 9, p. 152):

> Derowegen soll auch in kirchen und schuelen kein theologus, professor, praedicant oder schuelmeister ufgenommen werden, er gelobe unnd schwere dann zuevorderst, daß er anderst nicht lehren wölle, dann waß Gotteß wortt und erwehntter wahren unverenderttenn Augspurgischenn Confession gemeeß sey, sonderlich aber auch sich mit mundt und hertz in affirmativa et negativa erklehre, das er in confessione richtigk und rein unnd nichtt catholisch oder papistisch, zwinglich oder calvinisch, widerteufferisch oder andern irrigen unnd widerigen secten verwanth unnd zugethann sey,

Wherefore also no theologian, professor, preacher or schoolmaster shall be received in churches and schools, except he first vow and swear that he will teach nothing else than what is agreeable to God's word and the aforesaid true, unaltered Augsburg Confession; and especially also declare himself with mouth and heart, *in affirmativa et negativa*, that he is right and pure in confession, and not catholic or papist, Zwinglian or Calvinist, Anabaptist, nor related or addicted to other erroneous and contrary sects.

#### 17.11.2 Waldeck: the FC in the ordination vow

Waldeck's ordination form, in a manuscript revision of the church order of 1556 that the editors date to about 1584 and record in their apparatus (Sehling 9, p. 173), copies Henneberg's question of 1582 (§17.6.2). The editors gloss the "formula of union" as the FC of 1577. **Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung* 1556, ordination form in the revision of about 1584** (Sehling 9, p. 292):

> Zum andern fragen wir, ob ihr auch ewern glauben und bekentnis richten wollet nach Gottes wordt, wie dasselbige in prophetischer und apostolischer heiliger schrifft verfasset, desgleichen nach den dreien hauptsymbolis, auch hierauß hergenommener wolgegrundeter wahrer Augspurgischen Confession, Apologia, Schmalkaldischenn Artickeln, kleinem und großem catechismo Lutheri sampt jeziger christlichen einigungsformul [=Konkordienformel von 1577], so saget es hiermit Gott und seiner heiligen christlichen kirchen, auch uns

Secondly we ask whether ye will also direct your faith and confession according to God's word, as the same is contained in the prophetic and apostolic holy Scripture, and likewise according to the three chief creeds, and the true, well-grounded Augsburg Confession taken therefrom, the Apology, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, together with the present Christian formula of union [= the Formula of Concord of 1577]? Then promise it hereby to God and his holy Christian church, and to us.

#### 17.11.3 Frankfurt: the Book of Concord in the ordination vow (1589)

The imperial city of Frankfurt put the Book of Concord into the questions of its ordination rite. The ordinand answers "Yea". **Frankfurt, *Agende*, 1589** (Sehling 9, p. 541):

> Wollet ir aber auch mit Gottes Hülff und Gnaden bey dem klaren, hellen und außgetruckten Wort Gottes, so in den Schrifften Mose, der Propheten und Aposteln begriffen und newlicher zeit in der Augspurgischen Confession, Schmalkaldischen Articuln, beyden Catechismen Lutheri und dem Christlichen Concordibuch widerholet und erklärt worden, trewlich und fleissig bleiben, auch allen Christlichen Ordnungen dieser Franckfurtischen Kirchen trewlich nachkommen? Antwort: Ja.

But will ye also, with God's help and grace, abide faithfully and diligently by the clear, bright and express word of God, which is contained in the writings of Moses, of the prophets and of the apostles, and hath lately been repeated and declared in the

Augsburg Confession, the Smalcald Articles, both Catechisms of Luther and the Christian Book of Concord; and also faithfully follow all the Christian ordinances of this church of Frankfurt? Answer: Yea.

The confessions are presented as a recent *repetition* of Scripture, not as a separate norm.

#### 17.11.4 Nassau: from Melanchthon's *Loci* to the Reformed confession (1564–1582)

The Nassau-Diez *Revers* of 1564 names the creeds, the CA and "Philip's *Loci*". It is a promise ("*angeloben und versprechen*"), not an oath. **Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener*, [1564]** (Sehling 10, p. 103):

> Puncten, welche diejenige, so zum predigampt in des wolgebornen u[nseres] g[nädigen] h[errn] etc. kirchen angenomen werden, angeloben und versprechen muß[en] laut der ordnung 1. Das sie die h[eilige] lahr nach der h. propheten und aposteln schriften in dem verstandte, wie der in symbolis Apostolico, Nicaeno und Athanasii, auch in der Augspurgischen Confession und locis Philippi ausgedruckt ist, rein und lauter treiben wollen und keine newe dogmata seen oder eigene und besondere formulas zureden, dardurch etwa uneinigkeitt und spaltung zwischen uns selbst oder ergernis bei dem volck entstehen mochte, gebrauchen,

Points which those who are received into the preaching office in the churches of the well-born, our gracious lord, etc., must vow and promise according to the ordinance: 1. That they will set forth the holy doctrine purely and clearly according to the writings of the holy prophets and apostles, in the sense expressed in the creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, and also in the Augsburg Confession and Philip's *Loci*; and will sow no new dogmas, nor use their own and peculiar forms of speech whereby disunity and division might arise among ourselves, or offence among the people.

By 1582 Nassau-Dillenburg had adopted the Reformed confession (Reformed). Its church order of that year required, before the Supper, a confession of "the Reformed doctrine" (§17.17.2).

#### 17.11.5 Nassau-Weilburg and Ysenburg: the unaltered CA (1576, 1588)

Nassau-Weilburg's visitors asked each pastor whether he taught the chief articles "as they are briefly set down in the unaltered Augsburg Confession". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574/1576** (Sehling 10, p. 306):

> Articul, darauff die Pfarrer und Kirchendiener zu befragen 1. Ob er die vornembste Articul unserer Christlichen Religion vermög Prophetischer und Apostolischer Schrifften, wie die in der ungeenderten Augspurgischen Confession, so in Anno [15]30 Keyser Carolen, dem V. dieses Namens, ubergeben worden, kürtzlich verfasset und in andern bewehrten Symbolis der reinen Evangelischen Kirchen (so der ungeenderten Augspurgischen Confession zugethan und verwandt seynt) widerholet werden, seiner befolhenen Gemeine fleissig und trewlich fürtrage.

Articles upon which the pastors and ministers of the church are to be asked: 1. Whether he set forth diligently and faithfully to the congregation committed to him the chief articles of our Christian religion according to the prophetic and apostolic writings, as they are briefly set down in the unaltered Augsburg Confession which was delivered in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles, the Fifth of that name, and repeated in other approved symbols of the pure evangelical churches (which are addicted and related to the unaltered Augsburg Confession).

The Agende of 1618 adds the Apology, the SA and the catechisms (Sehling 10, p. 233). In 1609 the same territory told its pastors to admit, with discretion, godparents who did not hold the unaltered CA in every point (§17.17.4).

The county of Ysenburg-Birstein gave its pastors a *norma doctrinae* of the creeds, the unaltered CA, the Apology, the SA and both catechisms. **Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588** (Sehling 10, p. 619):

> Erstlich sollen die Pfarrherrn und Kirchendiener eine gewisse normam Doctrinae haben, darnach sie sich in Erkanntnuß und Underscheidt der rechten und falschen Lehr richten mögen. Sollen auch nichts anders lehren, dann was der Propheten und Apostel Schrifft, den bewerthen Symbolis unnd der unverenderten Augspurgischen Confession, Anno 1530 uberantwort, sampt derselbigen Apologi, So wol auch den Schmalkaldischen Artickeln und beyden Catechismis Lutheri gemeß ist.

First, the pastors and ministers of the church shall have a certain *norma doctrinae*, whereby they may govern themselves in knowing and distinguishing right and false doctrine. They shall also teach nothing else than what is agreeable to the Scripture

of the prophets and apostles, the approved creeds, and the unaltered Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 1530, together with the Apology thereof, as also to the Smalcald Articles and both Catechisms of Luther.

The FC is not named. The order goes on to tell pastors to read Luther and Philip.

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## 17.12 The Palatinates: Kurpfalz, the Upper Palatinate, Pfalz-Neuburg, Pfalz-Zweibrücken and Sponheim

The Wittelsbach Palatinates show more clearly than anywhere else how a single binding formula could carry different confessions in turn. The Kurpfalz *Kirchendienerbestallung* kept its wording through four reigns while its content changed:

| Reign | Confessional content |
|---|---|
| Ottheinrich (1556) | Lutheran: CA, Apol, SA and Luther's catechism |
| Ludwig VI (1580) | Lutheran: the Book of Concord |
| Johann Casimir (1586) | Reformed: the Heidelberg Catechism, with the CA and Apol "in their right sense" |
| Friedrich IV (1601) | Reformed: bound "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath" |

The Upper Palatinate, which had signed the FC in 1581–82, was released from it in 1585 under the Reformed regent. Pfalz-Neuburg stayed Lutheran and signed. Pfalz-Zweibrücken, then Lutheran, drew up its own Latin subscription in 1564, which Strasbourg also used. The Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim took the FC as "the symbol" of the Lutheran churches in 1608.

### 17.12.1 Kurpfalz: one formula, four confessions (1556–1601)

Ottheinrich's church order of 1556 binds pastors to the creeds, the CA and Apology of 1530 "in their right, unfalsified sense", the SA and Luther's catechism. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556** (Sehling 14, pp. 114–115):

> daß ihr in euerer lehr, predigt und gantzem kirchenampt bey der richtschnur göttlichs worts bleiben und davon weder zur rechten noch zur linkken abweichen, […] und in eurem lehren, predigen und conferieren etc. den alten bewerten symbolis Apostolico, Niceno und Athanasiano, der Augspurgischen Confession und deren Apologia (wie dieselb von den christlichen churfürsten und stendenkeyser Carolo dem fünften anno etc. 1530 in ihrem rechtem, unverfelschtem verstand, darauf wir uns jederzeit und noch mit mund und hertzen berufen und biß an unser ende mit verleihung göttlicher gnaden darbey bestendiglichen zu bleiben gedencken überantwort), deßgleichen bey den Schmalkäldischen Artickeln, dem Catechismo Lutheri, wie solcher diser unser kirchenordnung einverleibt, euch gemäß verhalten und nichts ungleichs oder widerwertigs einmengen oder einfüren.

that ye abide by the rule of God's word in your doctrine, preaching and whole church office, and turn not aside therefrom to the right hand nor to the left […]; and that in your teaching, preaching and conferring, etc., ye behave yourselves agreeably to the old approved creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and the Athanasian, and to the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof (as the same was delivered by the Christian electors and estates to the emperor Charles the Fifth in the year 1530, in its right, unfalsified sense, whereunto we have at all times appealed and do still appeal with mouth and heart, and purpose by the grant of divine grace to abide steadfastly thereby to our end), and likewise to the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism as it is incorporated in this our church order; and mingle or bring in nothing unlike or contrary.

Under Ludwig VI (1576–1583), who restored Lutheranism after his father's Reformed reign, the formula was extended to the Book of Concord. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1580** (Sehling 14, p. 507):

> Und nachdem die streitigen religionspuncten wider das bapstthumb und die secten in der Augspurgischen Confession und derselbigen Apologia nach rechtem verstandt der prophetischen und apostolischen schriften erklährt, sollet und werdet ihr bey gedachter Confession und Apologia, deßgleichen bey dem von churfürstlicher Pfaltz, auch etlicher ander churfürsten, fürsten, grafen, herrn und ständen deß reichs, deren kirchen und schulen approbiertem Concordibuch bleiben und kein alte oder neue opinion oder secten, so derselbigen zuwider, eynführen noch vertheidingen,

And forasmuch as the points of religion in controversy against the papacy and the sects are declared in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof according to the right understanding of the prophetic and apostolic writings, ye shall and will abide by the said Confession and Apology, and likewise by the Book of Concord approved by the Electoral Palatinate and

also by certain other electors, princes, counts, lords and estates of the empire, [and] their churches and schools; and shall neither bring in nor defend any old or new opinion or sect contrary thereto.

Six years later, under the Reformed administrator Johann Casimir, the same sentence returns without the Book of Concord. The catechism that "directs" the pastor to the CA is now the large and small Heidelberg Catechism, as the editors note. **Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1586** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 525):

> Und nachdem die streitigen religionspuncten wider das papstumb und die secten in der Augspurgischen Confession und derselbigen Apologia nach rechtem verstandt der prophetischen und apostolischen schriften erklärt, sollet und wedet ihr bey gedachter Confessio und Apologia, inmassen euch dahin der groß und klein catechismus, von neuem ubersehen und der kirchenordnung eynverleibt, weisen, endlich bleiben

And forasmuch as the points of religion in controversy against the papacy and the sects are declared in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof according to the right understanding of the prophetic and apostolic writings, ye shall and will abide finally by the said Confession and Apology, in such measure as the Large and Small Catechism, newly revised and incorporated in the church order, directeth you thereto.

The 1586 text is thus a Reformed subscription to the CA, read through the Heidelberg Catechism. By 1601 the schoolmasters' *Bestallung* was written in the first person. It ends with a pledge "with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath", confirmed by the man's own signature. **Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung*, 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 593):

> Dieses alles stedt, fest und unverbruchlich zu halten, auch alles ander zu leisten, was einem getreuen schuldiener und gehorsamen underthanen gebüret und wol anstehet, thue ich mit handgebner treu an eines leiblichen geschwornen eids statt hiemit geloben und mich dessen mit eigner underschrift verpflichten und verbinden, getreulich und sonder gefehrde.

All this to hold steadfast, firm and inviolable, and also to perform all else that becometh and well beseemeth a faithful schoolmaster and obedient subject, I do hereby vow with fealty given by the hand in the stead of a bodily sworn oath, and do oblige and bind myself thereto with my own signature, faithfully and without guile.

The same handfast pledge "in the stead of an oath" appears in Pfalz-Neuburg's *Bestallung* of 1555 (Sehling 13, p. 108).

#### 17.12.2 The Upper Palatinate: released from the Book of Concord (1585)

The instruction of 1585 is a Reformed order.

The Upper Palatinate's clergy signed the FC in 1581–82 (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 13, p. 269). When Johann Casimir took over the regency, his instruction to the church council of 1585 defined the CA by its later repetitions at Frankfurt (1557/58) and Naumburg (1561). The editors' footnote calls this "entirely in the sense of the so-called *Variata*". The instruction then released the ministers from their obligation to the BoC. **Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion*, 3 March 1585** (Reformed; Sehling 13, pp. 328–329):

> dann der confession, uf dem reichstag zue Augspurg anno [15]30 keiser Carolo ubergeben, und angehafter apologien, in dem rechten und gesunden verstand, wie sie damals von den christlichen chur- und fürsten gemeint und hernacher auf etlichen underschiedlichen ver[…]Besamblungen - als anno [15]57 und [15]58 zu Frankfurt - und [15]61 zu Naumburg - von churfürsten und stenden vorbesagter augspurgischen confession repetirt, widerholet und ercleret, auch von deren theologis ausgefueret und verteidingt worden ist, […] Weilen man allein uf Gottes wort als die unteilbare richtschnur sehen und auf keine menschenschriften oder autoritet sich verbünden soll, so befelhen und wöllen wir, das alle unsers obigen fürstentumbs zu Bayern kirchen- und schuldiener ihrer des concordibuch getoner pflichten halber allerdings erlassen und fürbas allein zu Gottes wort und zu dem obgesetzten verbunden und in pflicht genomen werden.

then [according to] the confession delivered to the emperor Charles at the diet at Augsburg in the year [15]30, and the apology annexed, in the right and sound sense, as it was then meant by the Christian electors and princes, and afterwards at sundry assemblies (as in the years [15]57 and [15]58 at Frankfurt, and [15]61 at Naumburg) repeated, rehearsed and declared by the electors and estates of the aforesaid Augsburg Confession, and also set forth and defended by their theologians, […] Forasmuch as we ought to look to God's word alone as the indivisible rule, and bind ourselves to no writings or authority of men, we command and will that all ministers of church and school in our aforesaid principality in Bavaria be wholly released from the

duty they took upon them to the Book of Concord, and henceforth be bound and taken into duty to God's word alone and to the [norm] set down above.

The phrase "to bind ourselves to no writings of men" is the Reformed answer to subscription as such.

#### 17.12.3 Pfalz-Neuburg: the Wittenberg Concord against the Calvinists (1564), the *corpus doctrinae* (1576)

Duke Wolfgang's mandate of 1564 against the Calvinists prescribed the "phrases and ways of speaking" for the Supper. They were to be taken from the CA, the Apology, the Wittenberg Concord of 1536, the SA and the church order. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*, 1564** (Sehling 13, p. 148):

> so wollen und bevelhen wir hiemit ernstlich, das alle unsere kirchendiener hinfur in iren predigen, auch privatunderrichtungen sonderlich, wan si den handl des Herren nachtmals erklern sollen - nicht neu, ungewondliche phrases und weis zu reden einfuren, sonder sich der phrases und weis zu reden allermaist gebrauchen, so in Gottes wort, augspurgischer confession, derselbigen apologia und zu Wittemberg in anno [15]36 aufgerichter concordia de caena Domini, auch in den schmalcaldischen artikln und unserer kirchenordnung gesetzt und begriffen sein.

we will and command hereby earnestly that all our ministers of the church henceforth, in their sermons and also in private instructions, especially when they are to explain the matter of the Lord's Supper, bring in no new, unwonted phrases and ways of speaking, but use most of all the phrases and ways of speaking that are set and contained in God's word, the Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof and the *concordia de caena Domini* set up at Wittenberg in the year [15]36, and also in the Smalcald Articles and our church order.

By 1576 these books were called the territory's *corpus doctrinae*, with the CA as "the symbol of the right, true church of our time". **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 171):

> das dieselbige zuvorderst der heiligen schrift selbst und dann auch den dreien symbolis apostolico, nicaeno, Athanatiano, desgleichen auch der augspurgischen confession, wie si anno 1530 kaiser Carolo Quinto ubergeben, als unserer zeit der rechten, wahrhaftigen kirchen symbolo, derselben apologien, schmalkaldischen artikeln und catechismo Lutheri nicht zuwider, sonder in allweg als dem reinen corpori doctrinae gemeß gefüert und, da jemand solchem zuwider geleret und uf seiner gefaßten irrigen opinion verharren, im furstentumb keineswegs geduldet werden solle.

that the same [exposition of Scripture] be conducted first of all agreeably to holy Scripture itself, and then also not contrary to the three creeds, the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's, nor likewise to the Augsburg Confession as it was delivered in the year 1530 to the emperor Charles the Fifth, as the symbol of the right, true church of our time, [nor] to the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechism, but in every way agreeably [to them] as to the pure *corpus doctrinae*; and that if anyone teach contrary thereto and persist in the erroneous opinion he hath conceived, he shall in no wise be suffered in the principality.

Pfalz-Neuburg later signed the BoC (Sehling's introduction, Sehling 13, p. 35).

#### 17.12.4 Pfalz-Zweibrücken: "*mente atque manu subscribo*" (1564)

Pfalz-Zweibrücken's Latin *Bekenntnisverpflichtung* of 1564 is the most elaborate personal subscription in the corpus. It is written in the first person and goes article by article:

- Scripture;
- *four* creeds: the Apostles', the Nicene, the Athanasian, and the Te Deum "thought to have been made by Augustine and Ambrose";
- the four councils;
- the CA of 1530, as understood by those who presented it;
- the history of its later editions;
- the SA, each with its own act of assent.

Strasbourg used the same text in 1565, and Sickingen in 1564. **Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener*, 1564** (Sehling 18, pp. 328–329):

> 1. Itaque amplector ex animo, omnia scripta Prophetarum et Apostolorum veteris et novi testamenti, quae sunt ipsum certum et indubitatum verbum Dei, […] 2. Deinde credo, amplector et confiteor quatuor illa catholicae ecclesiae symbola: Apostolicum, Nicenum, Athanasianum et quod ab Augustino atque Ambrosio confectum putatur. […] 4. […] toto pectore amplector et recipio eam doctrinae religionis formulam et summam, quae scripto exhibita est ab Illustrissimi Saxoniae Electore et aliis Principibus et duabusque civitatibus Nurnberga et Reutlinga Imperatori Carolo V. Augustae Vindelicorum anno 1530, quae inde Augustana confessio est nominata. […] Ego igitur his Smalcaldicis articulis quos veros et sacras scripturae conformes esse agnosco et confiteor (habent enim certa et indubitata Propheticorum et Apostolicorum librorum testimonia) ex animo, ut sunt κατα το ρητον positi, assentior et sine ulla sophistica his mente atque manu subscribo.

1. Therefore I embrace from my heart all the writings of the prophets and apostles of the Old and New Testaments, which are the very certain and undoubted word of God […] 2. Then I believe, embrace and confess those four creeds of the catholic church: the Apostolic, the Nicene, the Athanasian, and that which is thought to have been made by Augustine and Ambrose. […] 4. […] with my whole heart I embrace and receive that form and sum of the doctrine of religion which was exhibited in writing by the most illustrious Elector of Saxony and other princes, and the two cities of Nürnberg and Reutlingen, to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg in the year 1530, which is thence named the Augsburg Confession. […] I therefore assent from my heart to these Smalcald Articles, which I acknowledge and confess to be true and conformable to the holy Scriptures (for they have the certain and undoubted testimonies of the prophetic and apostolic books), as they are set down according to the letter; and without any sophistry I subscribe them with mind and hand.

"*κατα το ρητον*", "according to the letter", excludes any reservation. Pfalz-Zweibrücken did not go on to the FC. By Sehling's account, Duke Johann announced the official rejection of the Book of Concord in 1580 (Sehling 18, p. 40).

#### 17.12.5 Sponheim: the FC as "the symbol of all pure churches" (1608)

The Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, a condominium of Baden and the Palatine house, had made the CA, Melanchthon's *Loci* and his *Examen* its *corpus doctrinae* in 1560 (Sehling 18, p. 636). In 1608 the visitors complained that some pastors had neither bought nor read the FC. **Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel*, 1608** (Sehling 18, p. 671):

> Es haben etliche pfarrer in der hindern Graveschaft Sponheim formulam concordiae nicht allein in ihre Bibliothecas nicht erkaufft, sondern auch zum theil nicht gelesen, welche doch nunmehr pro symbolo aller reinen kirchen der unverfelschten Augspurgischen Confession gehalten wirdt, auch weilandt H[errn] Carol, Pfalzgravens christmilter gedechtnuß, eigentlicher will gewesen, daß so wol s.f.gn. kindere alß auch die landtsunderthanen dahin gewiesen werden sollen.

Certain pastors in the Hinder County of Sponheim have not only not bought the *formula concordiae* for their libraries, but also in part have not read it; which is nevertheless now held *pro symbolo* of all pure churches of the unfalsified Augsburg Confession; and it was also the express will of the late Lord Charles, Count Palatine, of Christian and gentle memory, that both his princely grace's children and the subjects of the land should be directed thereto.

The article goes on to require every pastor to buy the octavo edition within a year and to declare in writing to both chancelleries whether he assented to all its articles (Sehling 18, pp. 671–672).

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### 17.13 Württemberg, Hohenlohe and the Swabian cities

Württemberg had its own confession, the *Confessio Virtembergica*, which Brenz drew up for the Council of Trent in 1552. From the 1550s it set that confession beside the CA. Its theologians, Andreae above all, were the authors of the Concord, and in 1577 the duke ordered every minister to sign the FC. Hohenlohe, Württemberg's neighbour, shows a different path. In 1578 it made its own *corpus doctrinae*. In 1581, on Andreae's advice, it cut that corpus down to the CA. From 1603 it bound its ministers to a local *Gründlicher Bericht* in place of the FC. The free cities of Swabia (Hall, Wimpfen, Ravensburg, Ulm) mostly signed. Some had their own local formula as well.

#### 17.13.1 Württemberg: the CA and the *Loci* (1547), the CA and "our Confession" (after 1559)

Duke Ulrich's visitation order of 1547 directs preaching to the CA and Apology, and sends the ordinary preachers to Melanchthon's later *Loci*, "for they are examined out of the same in the synods". **Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1547**

(Sehling 16, p. 155):

> Die Leer unnd das Predig Ambt belanngenndt, sollenn sie dieselbigen alle auff die mainung unnd Innhallt der Augspurgischen Confession unnd darauff gevolgte Apologia richten unnd darwider nichts news oder widerwertigs fürgeen lassenn, unnd sonnderlich die gemeinen predicanten zu solhen, desgleichen auf die Locos Communes philippi recentiores weisen, dann sie in den Sinodis aus denselbigenn examinirt werden.

As touching doctrine and the preaching office, they shall direct them all according to the meaning and content of the Augsburg Confession and the Apology that followed thereon, and suffer nothing new or contrary thereto to go forth; and especially they shall direct the common preachers to the same, and likewise to the later *Loci communes* of Philip, for they are examined out of the same in the synods.

Under Duke Christoph the *Iuramentum und Promissio* of the ministers named two confessions: the Augsburg and "our Confession", the Württemberg Confession of 1552. **Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener*, [after 1559]** (Sehling 16, p. 424):

> Iuramentum und Promissio der Kirchendiener Unsers Fürstenthumbs. […] Und nach dem die erklärung solcher Artickel, darinn man in Glaubens sachen zu diser zeit strittig, in der Augspurgischen und unser Confession kurtz und klar, nach anweisung des rechten, waren, catholischen verstands der prophetischen und apostolischen Schrifft begriffen und verfaßt seind, so erfordert die notturfft des Kirchenampts, das der Kirchendiener in solchen Artickuln sein Lehr nach der erklärung und inhallt der zweien bemelten Confessionen getrewlich verrichte.

*Oath and promise of the ministers of the church of our principality.* […] And forasmuch as the explanation of such articles as are at this time in controversy in matters of faith is comprehended and set down briefly and plainly in the Augsburg Confession and in our Confession, according to the direction of the right, true, catholic sense of the prophetic and apostolic Scripture, the need of the church's office requireth that the minister of the church perform his teaching in such articles faithfully according to the explanation and content of the two said Confessions.

#### 17.13.2 Württemberg: the mandate to sign the FC (1577)

Duke Ludwig's mandate of 1577 sent the FC to the church and told every theologian and every minister of church and school to sign it. The FC is described as wholly conformable to the earlier norm, the Württemberg Confession "delivered at Trent" included. The duke notes that the electorates of Saxony and Brandenburg had already signed. **Württemberg, *Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel*, 1577** (Sehling 16, p. 445):

> das sie zuvorderst der hailigen, göttlichen schrifft, den dreyen alten unnd bewerten Symbolis, der christlichen Augspurgischen Confession, derselben Apologi, auch unnser vor diser Zeit publicierter unnd zu Trient überraichter christlicher Confession, den Schmalkaldischen Articuln, auch Katechismus Lutheri durchaus gleichförmig […] unnd nunmehr vielgedachte formula Concordie in baiden Churfürstenthumb, Sachsen unnd Brandenburg, von allen Theologen, Kirchen- unnd schuldienern albereit unnderschriben wurdt. […] das wir auch in unserm Fürstenthum vilgemelte, hiemit uberschickte Schrifften durch alle unsere Theologen, Kürchen- unnd Schuldienern (zue gezeugnuß des christlichen Consensus) unnderzaichnen lassen sollen

that they are first of all wholly conformable to the holy divine Scripture, the three old and approved creeds, the Christian Augsburg Confession, the Apology thereof, and also our Christian Confession published before this time and delivered at Trent, the Smalcald Articles, and also Luther's Catechism […]; and the oft-mentioned *formula Concordiae* is now already subscribed in both electorates, Saxony and Brandenburg, by all theologians and ministers of church and school. […] that we also in our principality should cause the oft-mentioned writings herewith sent to be signed by all our theologians and ministers of church and school (in witness of the Christian consensus).

The Limpurg church order of 1610 likewise binds its ministers to the CA and the FC (Sehling 16, p. 611).

#### 17.13.3 Hohenlohe: an own corpus (1578), cut down (1581), and the *Gründlicher Bericht* (1603–1615)

Hohenlohe's church order of 1578 opens with a *corpus doctrinae*. The church is to hold it "affirmatively and negatively", and so are both "teachers and hearers". **Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 260):

> bekennen sich diser grafschaft kirchen zu nachfolgenden schriften und büchern, als darinnen die ewige und unwandelbare göttliche warheit in allen und jeden stücken unserer warhaften, christlichen rehgion begriffen und erklert ist. Sollen auch dieselben beides lehrer und zuhörer pro corpore cloctrinae affirmative und negative halten, nembhchen: 1. Die schriften der heiligen propheten und apostel altes und newes testaments, fals die eiihge normam iudicii in allen controvershs. [...] 2. Die drey alten symbola, als apostolicum, nicenum und Athanash. 3. Die augspurgische confession, wie sie anno etc. [15]30 keiser Carolo V. zu Augspurg auf clem

the churches of this county confess themselves to the writings and books following, as wherein the eternal and unchangeable divine truth is comprehended and declared in all and every part of our true Christian religion. And both teachers and hearers shall hold the same *pro corpore doctrinae*, affirmatively and negatively, namely: 1. The writings of the holy prophets and apostles of the Old and New Testament, as the only *norma iudicii* in all controversies. [...] 2. The three old creeds, namely the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's. 3. The Augsburg Confession, as it was [delivered] in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles V at Augsburg at the …

The apparatus records the order's later life:

- In the printer's copy the CA is qualified "unaltered in words and meaning".
- A hand in the Stuttgart copy added "7. *Die formulam concordiae*".
- The reissue of 1688 reads "7. The *formula concordiae*, published and subscribed in the year 1580".

The apparatus also quotes the *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, in which Andreae himself advised dropping the *Repetitio* and Melanchthon's *Loci* from the list. As the editors note, FC II had condemned the teaching of the *Loci* on free will. The corpus was cut down to Scripture, the creeds and the CA. **Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, quoted in the apparatus to the *Kirchenordnung* of 1578** (Sehling 15, p. 261):

> dieweil es aber mit gedachter repetition augspurgischer confession und den locis Philippi ein solche gelegenheit, wie im protocoll fol. 17 und 18 zu befinden, so vermeinet demnach D. Jacob [Andreä], zank, zwitracht, auch kunftige gefahr der khchen zu verhuetten, das ermelte bucher außzulaßen, und man sich in disem ersten capitel nach Gottes wort zum buch der concordien bekennet, darin obgesetzte reyne bucher sambt gruntlicher erklerung der strittigen articul begriffen. Daruff ist verabschiedt worden, das man sich nach der bibel und die 3 symbola simpliciter nur [!] uf die augspurgische confession, wie sie anno etc. [15]30 kayser Carolo zu Augspurg ubergeben in der kirchenordnung referiren und solche pro corpore doctrinae halten solle.

but since the matter standeth so with the said repetition of the Augsburg Confession and the *Loci* of Philip, as is to be found in the protocol, fol. 17 and 18, Dr Jacob [Andreae] is therefore of opinion, in order to prevent strife, discord and also future danger to the church, that the said books be left out, and that in this first chapter [the church] confess itself, after God's word, to the Book of Concord, wherein the aforesaid pure books are comprehended, together with a thorough explanation of the articles in controversy. Whereupon it was resolved that, after the Bible and the three creeds, [the church] should refer itself in the church order simply and only [!] to the Augsburg Confession as it was delivered in the year [15]30 to the emperor Charles at Augsburg, and hold the same *pro corpore doctrinae*.

Sehling's "[!]" marks the outcome. Andreae advised confessing the BoC, but the counts decided to name the CA alone. The ministers' oath of 1588 binds to the church order and its ceremonies rather than to any confession by name. **Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener*, 1588** (Sehling 15, p. 562):

> Ir werdet geloben und schweren, das ir euer anbevolhen arnbt des heihgen ministerii bestes und getreues vlais auswarten, euch der graveschaft küchenordnung allerdings gemes verhalten, in derselben ohne sembthcher graven von Hohenloe etc. vorwissen und bevelich nichzit endern, weder ichtwas davon oder darzu tun,

Ye shall vow and swear that ye will wait upon the office of the holy ministry committed to you with your best and faithful diligence; behave yourselves altogether agreeably to the church order of the county; and change nothing therein without the foreknowledge and command of all the counts of Hohenlohe together, etc., neither take anything therefrom nor add anything thereto;

From 1603 the counts made a local doctrinal book, the *Gründlicher Bericht* (printed 1605), the norm in place of the FC. The partition treaties of 1609–1615 bound every minister to it by signature, oath and *Revers*. **Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge*, 1609–1615** (Sehling 15, p. 674):

> Insonderheit aber unß mit allem vleiß angelegen sein laßen, damit in allen und jeden kirchen und schulen nach anleitung jungstern in anno etc. 1605 under unßer grave Wolffgangs namen außgangenen büchleins (so intituhrt ist: Gründlicher bericht auß heiliger, göttlicher sclnfft von den vornembsten articuln christlicher lehr) daß lauter und rein wort [...] Gottes durch alle und jede dießer graveschaft kirchendiener den zuhörern und undertanen ohnverfälscht vorgetragen und geprediget und unnöttiger zank und spaltungen destomehr verhüettet werden. Subscriptiones und pflichtleistung der kirchendiener Inmaßen dan dießem allem also nachzukommen, alle kirchendiener und lehrer mit mund und hand zusagen, auch solche formulam doctrinae mit aignen handen pure underschreiben und darüber gewöhnliche leibliche aydspflicht neben ubergebung ihrer scln'iftlichen revers wurklichen leisten und darbey versprechen sollen,

But in especial [we will] let it be our care with all diligence that in all and every church and school, according to the direction of the little book lately put forth in the year, etc., 1605 under the name of our Count Wolfgang (which is entitled: *A thorough report out of the holy divine Scripture of the chiefest articles of Christian doctrine*), the clear and pure word [...] of God be set forth and preached unfalsified to the hearers and subjects by all and every minister of the church of this county, and unnecessary strife and divisions be so much the more prevented. *Subscriptions and duty of the ministers of the church.* Insomuch that, to fulfil all this, all ministers of the church and teachers shall promise with mouth and hand, and also subscribe such *formula doctrinae* purely with their own hands, and thereupon actually perform the customary bodily oath of duty, together with the delivery of their written *Revers*, and promise therewith

By Sehling's account, the FC was restored in Hohenlohe in 1630 (Sehling 15, pp. 17, 675–679).

#### 17.13.4 Ulm and Limpurg

Ulm's instructions for the officials of its rural territory (1567) bound the pastors to the CA, the Apology and Ulm's own "subscribed" confession on the Lord's Supper, "which came forth publicly in print" (Sehling 17/2, p. 270). In 1586 the preachers reported that doctrine was taught throughout Ulm's territory according to Scripture, the CA, the Apology, the SA "and the Concord lately subscribed" (Sehling 17/2, p. 277).

#### 17.13.5 Schwäbisch Hall, Wimpfen and Ravensburg

At Schwäbisch Hall, ordinands subscribed the Book of Concord together with the city's church order. **Schwäbisch Hall, ordination, *Kirchenordnung* 1614/15** (Sehling 17/1, p. 184):

> Zum vierdten sollen die ordinierten Personen ernstlich ermahnet werden, daß sie sich beydes, in der Lehr unnd im Leben, unverweißlich verhalten wöllen etc. Dessen zu mehrer caution sollen sie dem Concordi Buoch [Konkordienbuch 1580, BSLK S. 735-1100] und diser Kirchen Ordnung subscribieren und underschreiben [„und underschreiben" fehlt Entwurf 1614].

Fourthly, the ordained persons shall be earnestly admonished that they will behave themselves without reproach both in doctrine and in life, etc. For the greater security thereof they shall subscribe and underwrite the Book of Concord [the Book of Concord of 1580] and this church order ["and underwrite" is wanting in the draft of 1614].

The imperial city of Wimpfen bound its clergy by oath and then by a written *Notula subscriptionis*. In it the signer confesses the CA of 1530 and the FC "with this my own handwriting", "by virtue of the oath performed". A passage struck through in the manuscript speaks of laying three fingers on the BoC printed at Tübingen in 1580. **Wimpfen, *Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen*, [after 1577]** (Sehling 17/2, p. 530):

> Notula subscriptionis Ich, N. N. von N., bekhenne mit dieser meiner aigenen hanndschrifft, die in anno aintausendt fünffhundert unnd dreyzig zu Augspurg kayser Carolo dem fünfften uberantwortter confession zusampt die Formula Concordiae mit allen ihren einverleibten puncten unnd articuln, khein außgenommen, in affirmativa der hayligen, göttlichen schrifft gemes unnd recht sein, will auch mit Gottes hilff darbey beständig (crafft gelaisten juraments) bleiben unnd darwider nichts heimblichs noch offentliches die zeit meines lebens zu lehren, zu predigen, zu thun mich understehen noch auch andern, die solches thun werden, beyfall thun. Actum den etc.

*Note of subscription.* I, N. N. of N., confess with this my own handwriting that the confession delivered at Augsburg to the emperor Charles the Fifth in the year one thousand five hundred and thirty, together with the *Formula Concordiae*, with all the points and articles incorporated in them, none excepted, are in the affirmative agreeable to the holy divine Scripture and right;

and I will also with God's help abide steadfastly thereby (by virtue of the oath performed), and will not undertake to teach, preach or do anything secret or open against it all the time of my life, nor give assent to others who shall do so. Done the, etc.

Ravensburg, a city of mixed confession, had its own local "formula concordiae", drawn up by the evangelical preachers in 1578. Every preacher signed it under the terms of his *Bestallung*, and it was renewed in 1617. **Ravensburg, *Konkordie und Kirchenordnung*, 28 January 1578, renewal of 1617** (Sehling 17/2, p. 500):

> Allßdann in dem verschinen fünffzehenhundert achtunndsibentzigisten jahr durch die herren prediger deß heyligen evangelii nach Augspurgischer Confeßion alhie zue Ravenspurg etwelcher darinnen angezogner motiven und ursachen wegen ein formula concordiae verfasset unnd von allen bißheero bestellten predigern innhallt ihrer bestallungen subscribirt worden,

Whereas in the past year fifteen hundred and seventy-eight, for certain motives and causes alleged therein, a *formula concordiae* was drawn up by the lords preachers of the holy gospel according to the Augsburg Confession here at Ravensburg, and hath been subscribed by all the preachers appointed hitherto according to the tenor of their *Bestallungen*,

Here, as at Danzig (§17.7.3), "formula concordiae" names a local agreement among the city's own preachers, not the FC of 1577.

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## 17.14 Franconia and Regensburg

Franconia gives the longest single record in the corpus. The Brandenburg-Ansbach priest's oath of 1528 survives with its later forms recorded in the apparatus, so that one text shows the whole development:

1. In 1528, an oath to the prince to preach "the holy gospel and word of God".
2. From 1570, an oath to the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA and a local "formula of concord".
3. From 1573, a printed *norma doctrinae* shared with Nürnberg.
4. From 1588, the Book of Concord.

Nürnberg refused the FC and kept the 1573 *norma doctrinae*. By the editors' account it remained Nürnberg's confessional standard into the nineteenth century. Its neighbours Windsheim and Weißenburg also refused the FC (Sehling 11, pp. 486, 656, 673). The imperial city of Regensburg, by contrast, made every minister sign the BoC with his own hand before the consistory.

### 17.14.1 Brandenburg-Ansbach: the priest's oath (1528, 1570, 1573, 1588)

The base text of 1528 is an oath of allegiance. It is sworn to the margrave and confirmed "by this my own handwriting", and it binds the pastor to nothing but the gospel. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Der evangelische Priestereid*, 1528** (Sehling 11, p. 107):

> Ich, N., erwelter oder berufner pfarher zu N., glob und schwer dem durchleuchtigen hochgeborenen fürsten herrn Georgen, markgrafen zu Brandenburg..., hiemit und in kraft dieser meiner aigen handschrift, daß ich das heilig evangelion und wort Gottes alts und neus testaments lauter und clar predigen soll und will und nichts, das dawider ist,

I, N., elected or called pastor at N., vow and swear to the most serene, high-born prince, Lord George, margrave of Brandenburg..., hereby and by virtue of this my own handwriting, that I shall and will preach the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments purely and clearly, and nothing that is against it,

The editors print the later wording from the surviving sworn copies. From 1570 to 1588 the clause reads (Sehling 11, p. 107):

> 1570 bis 1588: das heilig evangelion und wort Gottes alts und neus testaments, der apostel und propheten schriften, den drei hauptsymbolis, der augsburgischen confession und derselben apologia, den schmalkaldischen artikeln und deren nächstverschiedenen siebenzigsten jahrs zwischen hochgedachten meines gnädigen herrn theologen und prädikanten verglichenen formulen concordiae gemäß lauter und clar

*1570 to 1588:* [that I shall preach] purely and clearly the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments, agreeably to the writings of the apostles and prophets, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, and the formula of concord agreed upon in the seventieth year last past between the theologians and preachers of my aforesaid gracious lord.

The "formula of concord" of 1570 is again a local one, an agreement among the margrave's own clergy. From 1573 the oath was followed by a list of books "of the *corpus doctrinae* and *norma judicii*". This is the list that Ansbach shared with Nürnberg. It names the CA in both its last edition and its first, "as ratified and subscribed at Naumburg in the year 61", and keeps the whole Melanchthonian canon. From 1577 the Concord was added (Sehling 11, p. 109):

> 1573-1588:+Verzeichnis der bücher corporis doctrinae et normae judicii Die 3 hauptsymbola — das apostolisch, nicänisch und Athanasii. Herrn D. M. Lutheri kleiner und großer katechismus. Die augsburgische konfession und sonderlich auch neben der letzten die 1. edition - lateinisch und deutsch -, so zu Naumburg anno 61 von kur- und fürsten ratifiziert und unterschrieben worden. Die apologia der augsburgischen konfession. Die schmalkaldischen artikel. Die repetitio der augsburgischen konfession, so zu dem concilio zu Trient vom kurfürsten von Sachsen übergeben worden. Die loci communes Philippi Melanchthonis. Das examen theologicum Philippi Melanchthonis. Die definitio appellationum Philippi Melanchthonis. Die responsiones Philippi Melanchthonis ad impios articulos bavaricos. Die responsiones Philippi Melanchthonis de controversia Stancari. Die brandenburgische kirchenordnung. [...] 1577-1588: + und sonderlich das concordiabuch

*1573–1588, added:* Register of the books of the *corpus doctrinae* and *norma judicii*. The three chief creeds: the Apostolic, the Nicene and Athanasius's. Master Dr M. Luther's Small and Large Catechism. The Augsburg Confession, and especially, beside the last [edition], also the first edition, Latin and German, which was ratified and subscribed by electors and princes at Naumburg in the year 61. The Apology of the Augsburg Confession. The Smalcald Articles. The Repetition of the Augsburg Confession, which was delivered by the Elector of Saxony to the council at Trent. The *Loci communes* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Examen theologicum* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Definitio appellationum* of Philip Melanchthon. The *Responsiones* of Philip Melanchthon to the impious Bavarian articles. The *Responsiones* of Philip Melanchthon on the controversy of Stancarus. The Brandenburg church order. [...] *1577–1588, added:* and especially the Book of Concord.

From 1588 the oath itself names the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA, both catechisms and the FC of 1580, "wherein the books just recounted are comprehended" (Sehling 11, p. 107):

> Seit 1588: das heilige evangelium und wort Gottes alten und neuen testaments, der propheten und apostel schriften, den drei hauptsymbolis, der augspurgischen confession und derselben apologia, den schmalkaldischen articuln, kleinen und großen catechismo Lutheri, der anno 1580 zwischen den evangelischen chur- und fürsten augsburgischer konfession verglichenen und in druck verfertigten formula concordiae, darinnen jetzt erzählte bücher samt gründlicher erklärung der zwischen etlichen theologen augsburgischer confession vorgefallenenen streitigen artikel verfaßt und begriffen, auch ihrer fürstlichen gnaden vor der zeit publizierten kirchenordnung gemäß lauter und klar.

*Since 1588:* [that I shall preach] purely and clearly the holy gospel and word of God of the Old and New Testaments, agreeably to the writings of the prophets and apostles, the three chief creeds, the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, the Smalcald Articles, Luther's Small and Large Catechism, the *formula concordiae* agreed upon in the year 1580 between the evangelical electors and princes of the Augsburg Confession and made ready in print, wherein the books just recounted are comprehended, together with a thorough explanation of the articles in controversy that arose between certain theologians of the Augsburg Confession, and also the church order published aforetime by his princely grace.

The Ansbach consistory order of 1594 made the BoC the subject of the candidate's first examination question. A man who had not read the whole book was given it to read, and examined only afterwards. **Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594** (Sehling 11, p. 388):

> sollen die verordneten unsers consistorii ihne zuvorderst befragen, ob er das buech der christlichen concordi, zwischen den christlichen churfürsten und stenden augspurgischer confession wie auch derselben theologen im 1580. jar publiciert, darinnen unserer kirchen einhellig bekanntnus vermög Gottes wort als der ainigen regul, norma und richtschnur, nach welcher alle lehrer und lehren gerichtet werden sollen, verfaßt, gelesen, nemblich die augspurgische confession, anno 30 Carolo V.dem römischen keyser ubergeben, sambt derselben apologia, den dreien symbolis, schmalkaldischen articuln und catechismis Lutheri mit angehengter christlicher und gründlicher erklerung etlicher strittigen articuln und unser kirchenordnung als unser corpus doctrinae und ob er mit allen diesen erzehlten schriften, so wir fur die göttliche ungezweifelte warheit halten, in allen und jeden articuln durchaus ainig und solche fur christlich und Gottes wort in allweg gemees erkenne und halte. Im fall er aber solche schrieften zuvor nicht gelesen hette, soll ime das ganze buech alsobald zu lesen zugestellt und, do solches von ime beschehen, alsdann erst zum examen zugelassen werden.

the appointed [members] of our consistory shall first of all ask him whether he hath read the Book of Christian Concord, published in the year 1580 between the Christian electors and estates of the Augsburg Confession and their theologians, wherein the unanimous confession of our churches is set down according to God's word as the only rule, norm and line by which all teachers and doctrines are to be judged, namely the Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 30 to Charles V, the Roman emperor, together with the Apology thereof, the three creeds, the Smalcald Articles and Luther's catechisms, with the Christian and thorough explanation of certain articles in controversy annexed; and our church order, as our *corpus doctrinae*; and whether he is wholly at one with all these writings recounted, which we hold for the divine undoubted truth, in all and every article, and acknowledgeth and holdeth them for Christian and in every way agreeable to God's word. But in case he hath not read such writings before, the whole book shall be given him straightway to read, and when he hath done so, then first shall he be admitted to the examination.

The same order binds the consistorial assessors by oath to the FC (Sehling 11, p. 384).

#### 17.14.2 Nürnberg and its neighbours: the 1573 *norma doctrinae* and the refusal of the FC

The Ansbach-Nürnberg *norma doctrinae* of 1573 has been given above. By Sehling's introduction, it had to be signed by all the clergy in both territories in 1573 (Sehling 11, p. 486). By the editors' note it was the confessional standard of Brandenburg-Ansbach and Nürnberg from 1573 to 1588, and of Nürnberg from 1573 "into the nineteenth century" (Sehling 11, p. 109). By Sehling's introductions:

- **Refused the FC:** Nürnberg (Sehling 11, p. 486), Weißenburg (p. 656) and Windsheim (p. 673).
- **Split:** at Wertheim the clergy refused, but the count signed for himself (p. 706).
- **Signed:** Rothenburg (p. 565). So did the Swabian cities of Kaufbeuren, Kempten, Lindau and Memmingen, and the clergy of Nördlingen and Oettingen (Sehling 12).

#### 17.14.3 Regensburg: the CA "in its right sense" (1567), the BoC signed before the consistory (1572/1588)

The imperial city's church order of 1567 receives the CA "in its right, true sense, which the letter giveth it". It condemns by name the Anabaptists, Zwinglians, Schwenckfelders, Antinomians and Osiandrians. Every minister is to be asked at his admission whether he holds the CA in this sense. **Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* (of 1567?)** (Sehling 13, p. 453):

> Und wie wir also annemen dieselbig confession in ihrem rechten, waren verstand, welchen ihr gibt der buchstabe, und apologia desselben 1530. jhars und hernach anno 1537 die artikel, zu Smalkalden gestelt und unterschrieben, auch allgemeiner christlicher consens unserer kirchen der augspurgischen confession und erklerung Lutheri, also verwerfen wir dagegen als irrig alles, was demselben verstand der augspurgischen confession zuwider ist, beide altes und neues, gegenwertiges und künftiges, als izt auch sind der widertaufer, zwingler, schwenckfelder, antinomer und osianderer etliche leren, bis solang wir eines andern aus heiliger schrift göttlichs worts überzeugt werden. Damit auch solche lere raine in unser kirchen bleibe und auf unsere nachkommen mit göttlicher verleihung möge gepflanzt werden, so ist versehen, das erstlich die kirchendiener alle darauf angenommen und austrücklichen gefragt werden, ob sie der reinen augspurgischen confession in ermeltem verstand und mit keiner andern widerwertigen lere behaft sind.

And as we thus receive the same confession in its right, true sense, which the letter giveth it, and the apology thereof of the year 1530, and afterward, in the year 1537, the articles set forth and subscribed at Smalcald, and also the general Christian consensus of our churches of the Augsburg Confession, and Luther's explanation; so on the other hand we reject as erroneous all that is contrary to that same sense of the Augsburg Confession, both old and new, present and to come, such as are now also certain doctrines of the Anabaptists, Zwinglians, Schwenckfelders, Antinomians and Osiandrians, until we be convinced otherwise out of the holy Scripture of God's word. And that such doctrine may remain pure in our church, and by divine grant be planted upon our descendants, it is provided that first of all the ministers of the church be all received thereupon, and be expressly asked whether they [hold] the pure Augsburg Confession in the said sense and are tainted with no other contrary doctrine.

The church government order of 1572, in its form of 1588, first records the confession of the chamberlain and council themselves (§17.17.5). It then requires every minister and schoolmaster, at the start of his appointment, to read the BoC, sign it "with his own hand" before the consistory, and declare himself on each disputed article before the council and the whole congregation. **Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 495):

> soll ein jeder kirchen- und schuldiener gleich anfangs seiner bestallung ermelt buch der concordien, nachdem er solches mit fleiß gelesen, vor den consistorialen mit 'eigener hand underschreiben und allda in specie aller secten, rotten und strittigen articuln halben inhalts ermelts buchs der Concordien unterschidlich und lauter erklären, vor einem erbaren rat und ganzen christlichen gemain, auch dessen ein offentliche bekentnus und zeugnus von sich geben.

every minister of church and school shall, at the very beginning of his appointment, after he hath read the said Book of Concord with diligence, subscribe it with his own hand before the consistorials, and there declare himself severally and plainly in particular concerning all sects, factions and articles in controversy according to the content of the said Book of Concord; and before an honourable council and the whole Christian congregation he shall also give a public confession and testimony thereof.

The order adds a note particular to a mixed city: "since we must, alas, dwell in this city within one ring wall with the papists", polemic is to be kept within bounds.

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## 17.15 Strasbourg and Alsace

Strasbourg, which had signed the *Tetrapolitana* in 1530 as a Moderate Reformed city, had subscribed the CA by 1532. Its path then ran in four steps:

1. **1549:** the CA in the examination of ministers, an order issued under the Interim.
2. **1562:** a public confession at admission according to the CA and the Apology, promised "*stipulata manu*".
3. **1563:** the Strasbourg Concord.
4. **1577:** the FC signed "*corde et manu*".

In 1598 the FC was put into the ordination vow. Colmar, by contrast, swore its preachers to the CA and Apology in 1575 and, now Moderate Reformed, refused to add the FC in 1578.

### 17.15.1 The CA in the examination (1549)

The eighth question of Strasbourg's examination order asks whether the candidate acknowledges the church of Strasbourg as a true church and the CA as "the sum of right Christian doctrine". **Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1549** (under the Interim; Sehling 20/1, p. 365):

> Der achte: Erkennet ir auch disse jetzige unsere kirche zu Straßburg für ain ware kirch Christi, unsers lieben herrn, und den inhalt unser Augspurgischen Confession für die summa recht Christlicher lehre?

*The eighth:* Do ye also acknowledge this present church of ours at Strasbourg for a true church of Christ our dear Lord, and the content of our Augsburg Confession for the sum of right Christian doctrine?

### 17.15.2 "*Stipulata manu*" (1562) and "*corde et manu*" (1577); the FC in the ordination vow (1598)

The order of service of 1577 tells the history in brief. In 1562 the council ordered that no one be admitted to the ministry who had not first made a public confession according to the CA and Apology, as newly approved at Naumburg. In 1577 the ministers agreed to admit no one who would not sign the FC "with heart and hand". **Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, [after August 1577]** (Sehling 20/1, p. 512):

> Die formulam doctrinae belangend ist anno 1562 durch ettliche abgeordnete herren vom rath einem ehrwurdigen kirchen convent, pfarrern und helffern befohlen worden, hinfurter keinen in den kirchen convent auffzunemen oder in das Strasburgische ministerium einzulassen, der nit zuvor sein bekentnuß von allen artickeln christlicher religion, wie die in der Augspurgischen confession und der selbigen Apologia (welche dazumal von den chur- und fursten und andern stenden Augspurgischer confession zur Naumburg auffs newe war approbirt und underschriben worden), offentlich gethan hette, welchem decreto senatus dazumal alle kirchendiener nachzukomen stipulata manu zusagten und versprachen. Demnach, als anno 1577 die Formula concordiae einem ehrsamen rath zu Straßburgk durch des […] hertzogs von Wirtenbergk legaten ist zugestelt und einhendig gemacht worden und die kirchen diener von andern orten derselben abschrifft bekomen und sie mit vleiß durchlesen und erwogen, haben sie sich alle einmütiglich verglichen, nit

> allein derselben gleichformig sich zu verhalten, sondern auch hinfort keinen in den convent auffzunemen, er underschreybe dan auch beyde corde et manu solch formula concordiae,

As touching the *formula doctrinae*: in the year 1562 it was commanded by certain lords deputed from the council to a reverend church convent, pastors and helpers, henceforth to receive no one into the church convent nor admit him into the ministry of Strasbourg who had not first made public his confession of all the articles of the Christian religion, as they are in the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof (which had at that time been approved anew and subscribed at Naumburg by the electors and princes and other estates of the Augsburg Confession); which decree of the senate all the ministers of the church then promised and undertook *stipulata manu* [with hand given in pledge] to obey. Afterwards, when in the year 1577 the *Formula concordiae* was delivered and handed to an honourable council at Strasbourg by the legate of the [...] duke of Württemberg, and the ministers of the church had received a copy of it from other places and had read and weighed it with diligence, they all agreed with one accord not only to behave themselves conformably thereto, but also henceforth to receive no one into the convent unless he also subscribe the said *formula concordiae* both *corde et manu* [with heart and hand].

The footnote records that the council was more reserved than its ministers. In May 1578 it told the duke that it would not be drawn into new controversies, and it appealed to the Strasbourg Concord of 1563. In 1565 the Strasbourg clergy had also used the Pfalz-Zweibrücken Latin subscription (§17.12.4).

The church order of 1598 put the FC into the ordination questions. **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 9 April 1598** (Sehling 20/1, pp. 640–641):

> II. Glaubt ihr auch steiff alles, das uns die heilige Göttliche Schrifft fürgibt Und was in den Symbolis oder Summen unsers Christlichen Glaubens, als im gemeinen Symbolo Apostolorum, den vier großen haubt Concilien, Auch in der Confession und Apologia, von Chur- und Fürsten auf dem Reichstag zu Augspurg anno 1530 ubergeben, und derselben einhelliger in anno 1580 publicierten Erklärung, welche die Formula Concordiae genennet wirdt, begriffen und widerholet ist? Begehret ihr auch, diesen Glauben zubekennen und zulehren mit besten Trewen biß an ewer Ende? [...] Antwort: Ich glaub und halt diß alles Und bitte Gott, das Er mich darinn ohn alles wancken biß in sein himmlischs Reich erhalten wolle.

II. Do ye also believe steadfastly all that the holy divine Scripture setteth before us, and that is comprehended and repeated in the creeds or sums of our Christian faith, namely in the common Creed of the Apostles, the four great chief councils, and also in the Confession and Apology delivered by electors and princes at the diet at Augsburg in the year 1530, and the unanimous explanation thereof published in the year 1580, which is called the *Formula Concordiae*? Desire ye also to confess and teach this faith with your best faithfulness unto your end? [...] *Answer:* I believe and hold all this, and pray God that he will preserve me therein without any wavering unto his heavenly kingdom.

### 17.15.3 Colmar: an oath on the CA, and the refusal of the FC (1575, 1578)

Colmar introduced the Reformation in 1575. Its preachers swore, besides their citizen's oath, to preach "agreeably to the Biblical Scriptures, together with the Fathers who agree with them, the Augsburg Confession and its Apology". They also swore not to condemn publicly those "who are still at variance in certain points in the reformed church". **Colmar, *Eid der Prediger*, 22 October 1575** (Sehling 20/2, p. 501):

> Es sollen die predicannten neben irem burger aydt schweren, das sy allein die byblische, hailige Altes unnd Newes Testamennts schrifften sampt den Patribus, so deren durchaus ubereinstymmen, der Augspurgischen confession und deren Apologi gemeß one schmahen, schennden unnd lestern Iheren [sic], predigen unnd die heiligen sacrament außteylen wellen. Item, das sy auch niemannden, der sey was religion der wolle, furnemblich die, so noch inn der reformierten kirchen ettlicher puncten streyttig, offennlich verdammen,

The preachers shall swear, beside their citizen's oath, that they will teach, preach and administer the holy sacraments only agreeably to the Biblical, holy Scriptures of the Old and New Testaments, together with the Fathers who agree with them throughout, [and] to the Augsburg Confession and the Apology thereof, without reviling, defaming and blaspheming. Item, that they will also openly condemn no one, be he of what religion he will, and especially those who are still at variance in certain points in the reformed church.

The words "and the Apology thereof" are a later addition in the margin. When the FC was urged on the city in 1578, the council, by now Moderate Reformed, declined. It had already tendered its preachers an oath, and it would not press the FC on them

against that oath. **Colmar, *Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel*, 10 May 1578** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 20/2, p. 509):

> jedoch so will unnß auß vorangeregten unnd erzelten ursachen, binn unnserm ann e[wer] f[urstlich] g[naden] außgangenen schreiben vermeldet, hochbedencklich sein, Formulam concordie wider von unnß unsern predigern einmal deferierdt und prestierdt juramentum (dessen inhalt e[wer] f[urstlich] g[naden] wir hievor zugeschickt) zu tringen. Bitten e[wer] f[urstlich] g[naden] darauff underthenigs vleiß, e[wer] f[urstlich] g[naden] wollenn unnß dißfalß fur entschuldiget halten unnd mit der subscribtion gnediglichen

yet for the causes aforesaid and recounted, set forth in our letter to your princely grace, it will seem to us a very grave matter to press the *Formula concordiae* [upon our preachers], against the oath once tendered by us to our preachers and performed by them (the content whereof we have sent to your princely grace before). We therefore beseech your princely grace with humble diligence that your princely grace will hold us excused herein, and graciously [spare us] the subscription.

The sworn oath is here the reason for refusing the further subscription.

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## 17.16 Transylvania

The Saxon church of Transylvania, outside the Empire, bound its ministers by oath to the CA. The Burzenland chapter resolved in 1573 that newly received ministers should be taught the CA so thoroughly that they could "swear to it solemnly with a good conscience" at the next convention. **Burzenland, *Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels zum Eid auf die Confessio Augustana*, 1573** (Sehling 24, p. 371):

> 5. Pastores, qui recens ad ministerium receperunt ministros, lectionem et cognitionem [Augustanae] [Confessionis] ita inculcent eis, ut in proximo conventu exemplo pastorum bona conscientia solenniter in eam iurare possint.

5. Let the pastors who have lately received ministers into the ministry so inculcate upon them the reading and knowledge of the [Augsburg] [Confession], that at the next convention, after the example of the pastors, they may with a good conscience solemnly swear to it.

In 1601 the newly elected superintendent swore before the altar to keep and defend the religion "contained in the CA … the Smalcald Articles and the ecumenical creeds". **Transylvanian Saxons, *Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl*, 1601** (Sehling 24, p. 480):

> Electus superintendens coram altari aperte, praeeunte voce sua domino Laurentio Kosch pastori Requiniensi iuramentum praestitit, se hactenus usitatam in ecclesiis Saxonicis Transsylvaniae religionem, in scriptis propheticis et apostolicis comprehensam, in confessione Augustana Carolo V. exhibitam et repetitam, articulis denique Schmalcaldicis et symbolis oecumenicis contentam constanter conservaturum ac defensurum.

The superintendent elect, before the altar, openly, Master Laurentius Kosch, pastor *Requiniensis*, going before with his voice, performed the oath that he would constantly keep and defend the religion hitherto used in the Saxon churches of Transylvania, comprehended in the prophetic and apostolic writings, exhibited and repeated in the Augsburg Confession to Charles V, and contained finally in the Smalcald Articles and the ecumenical creeds.

The FC is not named. The norm is the CA, the SA and the creeds, sworn to as the received religion of a church that lived alongside Catholics, Reformed and Unitarians.

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## 17.17 The laity: confirmation, communion, godparents, citizenship and office

No order in the corpus requires ordinary lay people to subscribe the CA, the FC or any *corpus doctrinae*. Where an order speaks of "teachers and hearers" being bound to the corpus, as at Thorn (1575, §17.7.3) and in Hohenlohe (1578, §17.13.3), it means the corpus is the standard of what the hearers are taught. It does not mean they are to sign it. The laity were bound in five other ways:

1. by **confirmation**, where a confirmation rite existed: a public profession of the catechism, a vow to remain in it, and, in the Hessian (Moderate Reformed) and Reformed forms, a submission to church discipline;

2. by the **examination before communion**, and in Reformed churches by an explicit confession of the Reformed doctrine;
3. by the **catechism test before marriage**, and in one case before admission as a burgher;
4. by rules for **godparents**;
5. for **magistrates and officials**, by oaths and, in some cities, by subscription.

#### 17.17.1 Confirmation: profession, vow and discipline

The Hessian church orders of 1539 (Moderate Reformed), written with Bucer's help, created the evangelical confirmation. The children are questioned on the chief articles before the congregation and "give themselves publicly to Christ the Lord and his church". The pastor lays hands on them and "confirms them to Christian fellowship". **Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 104):

> Es sollen auch die eltesten und prediger versehen, daß die kinder, so nun durch die catechismos im christlichen verstande so weit bracht sein, daß man sie billich solle zum tisch des Herren zulassen, uf ein fürnemes fest, als Ostern, Pfingsten und Weihnachten, für aller gemein dem pfarherr an darzu verordnetem ort von ihren eltern und pettern dargestellet werden, umb den die eltesten und alle ander diener des worts stehen sollen. Da solle der pfarherr dieselbigen kinder die fürnemsten stücke des christlichen glaubens befragen, und nachdem die kinder darauf geantwort, sich auch da offentlich Christo dem Herren und seiner kirchen ergeben haben, soll der pfarherr die gemein vermanen, den Herrn diesen kindern umb bestendigkeit und merung des h. Geistes zu bitten und solches gebet mit einer collect beschließen. Dem allem nach soll dann der pfarherr denselbigen kindern die hende auflegen und sie also im namen des Herrn confirmieren und zu christlicher gemeinschaft bestetigen, auch darauf zum tisch des Herren gehen heißen,

The elders and preachers shall also provide that the children who have now been brought so far in Christian understanding by the catechisms that they may rightly be admitted to the Lord's table, be presented on some chief feast, as Easter, Whitsuntide and Christmas, before the whole congregation, by their parents and godparents, to the pastor at a place appointed for it, about whom the elders and all other ministers of the word shall stand. There the pastor shall question the same children on the chief parts of the Christian faith; and after the children have answered thereto, and have also there given themselves publicly to Christ the Lord and his church, the pastor shall exhort the congregation to pray the Lord for these children for steadfastness and the increase of the Holy Ghost, and shall close such prayer with a collect. After all this the pastor shall lay hands on the same children, and so confirm them in the name of the Lord and establish them in Christian fellowship, and thereupon bid them go to the Lord's table,

The Kassel church order of the same year (Moderate Reformed) gives the questions. The child professes that he is in the church by baptism and vows to remain in its fellowship. He also promises to obey God's word and to accept rebuke from the elders. The running head of the page is misprinted "1589". **Hesse, *Kasseler Kirchenordnung*, 1539** (Moderate Reformed; Sehling 8, p. 125):

> Frag: Bistu auch in der kirch und gemein Christi ? Antwort: Ja - Frag: Wie bistu darein kommen? Antwort: Durch den heiligen tauf. — Frag: Was ist der? Antwort: Das bad der widergeburt, dadurch ich von der angebornen sund gewaschen, Christo meinem Herren eingeleibet und mit ihm bekleidet worden bin. — Frag: Wiltu in der gemeinschaft erharren ? Antwort: Ja, durch die hülf des Herren in ewigkeit. — Frag: Was vermag diese gemeinschaft der kirchen Christi ? Antwort: Daß ich mich in aller gehorsam halt göttlichs worts, dasselbig von den verordeneten dienern der kirchen zun gesetzten zeiten und vornemlich uf die sontag mit recht gleubigem herzen höre, auch so mich die eltesten der kirchen oder auch andere christen, welche ja die seien, der sunde straffen, daß ich das in aller demut zur besserung aufnehm,

*Question:* Art thou also in the church and congregation of Christ? *Answer:* Yea. *Question:* How camest thou thereinto? *Answer:* Through holy baptism. *Question:* What is that? *Answer:* The washing of regeneration, whereby I have been washed from inborn sin, incorporated into Christ my Lord, and clothed with him. *Question:* Wilt thou continue in the fellowship? *Answer:* Yea, by the help of the Lord, for ever. *Question:* What requireth this fellowship of the church of Christ? *Answer:* That I keep myself in all obedience to God's word, and hear the same with a rightly believing heart from the appointed ministers of the church at the set times, and chiefly on the Sundays; and also, if the elders of the church or other Christians, whosoever they be, rebuke me for sin, that I receive it in all humility for amendment,

This is a vow of membership, not of confession. The child binds himself to the church's fellowship and discipline, and no book is named. Strasbourg's church order of 1553 introduced the same rite, "after confession made and free surrender to the discipline and obedience of the church". **Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach*, 1553** (Sehling 20/1, p. 396):

> Solche christliche und gantz notwendige ceremoni in der kirchen wider anzurichten, die getaufften kinder, nach dem sie jetz den catechismum erlernett, offentlich der kirchen furzustellen und die nach gethoner bekantnuß und freywilligem ergeben in die zucht und gehorsame der kirchen mit hennd aufflegung unnd dem gleubigen gebett dem herren, unserm Gott, und seiner lieben gemeind zubefelhenn,

To set up again in the church this Christian and altogether needful ceremony: to present publicly to the church the baptized children, after they have now learned the catechism, and, after confession made and free surrender into the discipline and obedience of the church, to commend them to the Lord our God and to his dear congregation with the laying on of hands and believing prayer,

The Reformed refugee church order of Marten Micron (Reformed), used in East Frisia, has three questions. They ask for answers on the chief parts of the catechism, for a vow to remain in "this confession of faith" and renounce the world and Satan, and for a vow to submit to Christian discipline. **East Frisia (Reformed), *Microns Ordinancien* (1554), 1565** (Sehling 7/1, p. 607):

> Zum ersten, daß sie auf die sonderlichste haupstücken der christlichen religion (von welchen sie nach der ordnung des kleinen catechismi gefraget werden), ein jeder besonder, aufs kürzest antwort geben. Zum andern, ob sie auch durch die gnade Gottes in diser bekentnuß des glaubens bestendig bleiben, darnach ihr leben richten und die welt und dem satan mit allem ihrem pracht verleugnen wollen ? Antwort: Ja, wir. Zum dritten, ob sie nicht auch sich der christlichen straffe (nach dem wort Gottes) willigliche unterwerfen wollen ? Antwort: Ja, wir.

First, that they give answer, each one severally and most briefly, upon the most special chief parts of the Christian religion (whereupon they are asked after the order of the small catechism). Secondly, whether they will also by the grace of God abide steadfast in this confession of faith, order their life thereafter, and renounce the world and Satan with all their pomp? *Answer:* Yea, we [will]. Thirdly, whether they will not also willingly submit themselves to Christian correction (according to the word of God)? *Answer:* Yea, we [will].

Electoral Saxony's order of 1580 has no laying on of hands. It teaches that the catechism examination is itself the "right Christian confirmation": the confirming of the faith that the godparents confessed at baptism in the child's stead. **Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580** (Sehling 1, p. 425):

> Und sollen die pfarrer und kirchendiener das volk fleissig unterweisen, und. mit gutem grund berichten, das dis sei die rechte christliche confirmation oder firmung, das ist die bestetigung des glaubens, so die paten an stadt des neugetauften kindleins bekant, darauf auch das kind getauft worden, wann sie nemlich solches in diesem examine erinnert, und demselben in ihrem ganzen leben nachzukommen, fleissig ermanet werden.

And the pastors and ministers of the church shall diligently instruct the people, and inform them with good ground, that this is the right Christian confirmation or firming, that is, the confirming of the faith which the godparents confessed in the stead of the newly baptized child, and whereupon also the child was baptized: namely when they are reminded of the same in this examination, and are diligently exhorted to follow it all their life long.

The confirmation rites themselves are treated in Chapter 13, §13.6, and the instruction before first communion and confirmation in Chapter 15, §§15.11.2–15.11.3.

#### 17.17.2 Admission to communion

The Lutheran orders required every communicant to be "explored", that is, examined and absolved, beforehand. Schweinfurt grounds this rule in the CA and the Apology themselves. **Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543** (Sehling 11, p. 640):

> soll niemand zum hochwirdigen sacrament gelassen werden, er habe sich denn des abents zuvor oder des morgens unter oder nach der mettin dem caplan angezeigt in aller mas, wie davon die unseren in der augspurgischen confession mit klaren, hellen, dürren worten eraus sagen und bekennen, nemlich in dem artikel von der messe: Nulli admittuntur nisi antea explorati, und in der apologia: Porrigitur sacramentum, his qui uti volunt, postquam sunt explorati atque absoluti.

no one shall be admitted to the most worthy sacrament unless he have announced himself to the chaplain the evening before, or in the morning during or after matins, in every manner as our [divines] say out and confess concerning it in the Augsburg Confession with clear, bright, plain words, namely in the article of the Mass: *None are admitted unless they have first been examined*; and in the Apology: *The sacrament is given to those who will use it, after they have been examined and absolved.*

Pfalz-Neuburg's general articles of 1576 apply the same rule to the young. They add a catechism test before marriage. **Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576** (Sehling 13, p. 176):

> 2. Es sollen auch die pfarrer und kirchendiener under dem jungen volk niemand zum hochwürdigen sacrament zulassen, der nicht sein catechismum gelernet und aus demselben seines glaubens notturftige rechenschaft geben kan. 3. Da si auch in den ehestand sich begeben, dieselbige beede, so lang nicht verkundiget oder eingesegnet werden sollen, bis si die sex haubtstuk christlicher lehr wol gelernet haben.

2. The pastors and ministers of the church shall also admit no one among the young people to the most worthy sacrament who hath not learned his catechism and cannot give a sufficient account of his faith out of the same. 3. When they also enter into the state of marriage, the two shall not be proclaimed nor blessed until they have well learned the six chief parts of Christian doctrine.

The Württemberg visitation order of 1557 deals with those who stay away from the Supper "on account of Zwinglian, Schwenckfeldian, Anabaptist or other sects". They are not refused a confession they never offered. They are visited privately, twice, and then a third time before two or three of the discipline-men. **Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1557** (Sehling 16, p. 331):

> oder da ainer sich der Zwinglischen, Schwenckhfeldischer, widerteufferischenn oder annderer secten halber des nachtmals Christi enteussern wöltte, so soll ain jeder Khirchendiener schuldig sein, dieselbige Person zum ersten unnd andern malen allain für sich zubeschikkhen unnd allso sie privatim mit allen gutten, christenlichen Leeren und ermanungen beschaidenlich berichtenn.

or if anyone would withdraw himself from the Supper of Christ on account of Zwinglian, Schwenckfeldian, Anabaptist or other sects, every minister of the church shall be bound to send for the same person alone, the first and the second time, and so instruct him privately and discreetly with all good Christian teachings and exhortations.

The Reformed orders went further. Nassau-Dillenburg (1582), once it had turned Reformed, admitted to the Supper only those who had made a confession of "the Reformed doctrine". This applied to strangers as well. **Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582** (Reformed; Sehling 10, p. 163):

> 43. Nemo ad coenam Domini admittatur, nisi qui confessionem doctrinae reformatae pro more ecclesiae ediderit et habeat testimonium honestae vitae, sine quibus non admittendi sunt etiam exteri.

43. Let no one be admitted to the Lord's Supper unless he have made a confession of the Reformed doctrine after the custom of the church, and have the testimony of an honest life; without which not even strangers are to be admitted.

This is the nearest thing in the corpus to a lay confessional test, and it is Reformed.

The examination of communicants in place of private confession is treated in Chapter 13, §13.17.4, and confession and communion as a duty of the laity in Chapter 15, §15.8.3.

### 17.17.3 Marriage and citizenship

A test of catechism knowledge could be a condition of civil standing. In the Reformed Kurpfalz in 1599 couples who could not recite the chief parts were not to be married. No such "ignorant" was to be received as a burgher or member of the commune without a written certificate from his pastor. **Kurpfalz, *Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht*, 1 February 1599** (Reformed; Sehling 19/2, p. 890):

> keine neue eheleute, welche die capita nicht erzehlen können, proclamiren oder einsegnen, wie dan zue diesem ende auch unser gnedigster herr den hiervorigen befelch an die amptleute renoviren lassen, das solcher ignoranten keiner zum bürger oder gemeinßman angenommen werden solle, er habe dan von dem pfarrer des orts (alda er sich gedencke niderzulassen) ein schriftlich urkund und zeugnuß ufzulegen, das er dieselbe zum wenigsten erzelen könne.

[ye shall] proclaim or bless no new married couple that cannot recite the chief parts; as to this end also our most gracious lord hath caused the former command to the officials to be renewed, that none of such ignorant persons shall be received as a burgher or member of the commune, unless he have a written certificate and testimony to show from the pastor of the place (where he purposeth to settle) that he can at the least recite them.

Earlier, the Margraviate of Baden's mandate against the Anabaptists (1543) had made a negative test a condition of settlement. One version, C in the apparatus, adds a clause: no one is to be received as burgher or *Hintersasse* unless it was first certain that he did not belong to the sect, with a sealed certificate of his former conduct. **Baden, *Wiedertäufermandat*, 1543, version C** (Sehling 16, p. 515):

> Es sollen auch hinfür die ambtleut kheinen zu [bu]rger [Text zerstört] oder hindersäßen aufnhemen oder gedülden, man seie denn zuvor vergwist, das er diser verfürischen Sect nit anhengig, sich auch zuvorn an verdechtlichten orten nit gehalten, und er beneben seinem Manrecht [war]haffte unnd versigelte urkhund seines hievorigen verhaltens und wesens khonne auflegen.

The officials also shall henceforth receive or suffer no one as burgher [text destroyed] or as *Hintersasse*, unless it be first made certain that he is not an adherent of this seducing sect, nor hath kept himself before in suspected places, and that he can show, beside his certificate of free birth, a true and sealed certificate of his former conduct and life.

The catechism examination before marriage is treated in Chapter 15, §15.11.4.

### 17.17.4 Godparents

The godparent was the one lay office in the Church's rites, and the orders differ on whether he must share the parish's confession.

**Excluded.** The Limpurg visitors (1611) were to ask whether the pastor "admits ignorant children and heterodox persons to be godparents". **Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1611** (Sehling 16, p. 629):

> 23. Ob er auch unverständige kinder undt Heterodoxos zue Gevatterschafften admittire.

23. Whether he also admit children without understanding and heterodox persons to be godparents.

**Examined first.** The synod of Wied (1564, Reformed) barred "men of another religion, who detest our evangelical doctrine", unless they had first been examined by the ministers and given an account of their faith. **Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 5 June 1564** (Reformed; Sehling 19/1, p. 466):

> 6. Ne pueri pro susceptoribus infantium in S. baptismatis administratione admittantur neve etiam alienae religionis homines, qui nostram doctrinam Evangelicam detestantur, nisi prius a ministris Ecclesiae examinati suae fidei rationem reddiderint.

6. That boys be not admitted as sponsors of infants in the administration of holy baptism, nor yet men of another religion who detest our evangelical doctrine, unless they have first been examined by the ministers of the church and have given an account of their faith.

**Admitted with discretion.** Nassau-Weilburg (1609) told its pastors that people who did not hold the unaltered CA in every point were not to be driven from the font, unless they were open blasphemers. The reason given is that the institution of godparents is "not an express command of God". **Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1609** (Sehling 10, p. 329):

> Nachdem es sich bißweilen begibet, das personen, so noch zur zeit der papisten aberglauben in vielen stucken zugethan oder sonsten sich nicht in allen puncten der reinen evangelischen lehr vermog der ungeenderten, in anno 30 ubergebenen Au[g]spurgischen Confession richtig finden konnen, zu gevattern gebetten werden, sollen die kirchendiender, weyl ohnedas die verordnung der gevattern nicht eben ein ausgetruckter befelch Gottes, sondern uß guten, erheblichen ursachen von menschen verordnet, in solchem fall vernunfftig und fursichtig handeln und nicht balt jemant, der nicht ein offentlicher lesterer Gottes, seines h. worts und der hochwurdigen sacramenten, von der h. tauf allerdings abtreiben und abhalten,

Forasmuch as it sometimes happeneth that persons who are still addicted in many things to the superstition of the papists, or otherwise cannot find themselves right in all points of the pure evangelical doctrine according to the unaltered Augsburg Confession delivered in the year 30, are asked to be godparents: the ministers of the church shall in such case deal reasonably and prudently (since the ordinance of godparents is not an express command of God, but was ordained by men for good and

weighty reasons), and not hastily drive away and keep altogether from holy baptism anyone who is not an open blasphemer of God, of his holy word and of the most worthy sacraments.

**Both religions admitted.** In biconfessional Soest the council confirmed in 1583 that, for the sake of peace, godparents of both religions, Roman and Augsburg, had been freely admitted, and it left the practice unchanged. **Soest, *Anweisung zu den Taufpaten*, 8 June 1583** (Sehling 22, p. 478):

> Nachdem biß anhero zu erhaltungh guttenn freidtstandtz unnd einigkeitt zwischenn beider religion, so woll der romischenn kirchenn alß dero Augßpurgischer unverfelscheter Confession, anno drißigh kay[serlicher] ma[jes]t[ä]tn ubergebenn, verwandtenn stenden das sacrament der hilger tauff einer mitt dem anderen zu haltenn, zubestehenn unnd zubekleidenn ohn underscheidt frey unnd zugelaßenn wordenn,

Forasmuch as hitherto, for the preserving of good peace and unity between the estates related to both religions, as well the Roman church as the unfalsified Augsburg Confession delivered in the year thirty to the imperial majesty, it hath been free and permitted without distinction for the one to hold, to stand at and to attend the sacrament of holy baptism with the other,

Godparents at baptism are treated in Chapter 13, §13.3.8.

### 17.17.5 Magistrates and officials

Lay office-holders were bound more strictly than the common people:

- **Councils.** The Heilbronn council swore in 1530, soon after the Diet of Augsburg, to stand by the council's majority "whether in the matter of the gospel or otherwise". The accompanying council ordinance says that the whole citizenry had been asked its mind and found willing.
- **The council as confessor.** The council of Regensburg made its own confession to the creeds, the CA, the Apology, the SA and Luther's catechism (1572).
- **Assessors.** Consistorial assessors swore to the church's confession in Ernestine Saxony (1569, §17.6.1), Prussia (1584, §17.7.2) and Ansbach (1594, §17.14.1).
- **City officials.** At Hildesheim in 1593 the burgomasters, syndics, physicians and secretaries signed the FC and its Apology "with their own hand" (§17.10.1).
- **Elders.** The Reformed Kurpfalz had its elders vow to the presbytery order (about 1601).

**Heilbronn, *Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben*, 18 November 1530** (Sehling 17/1, p. 290):

> Es solle ein yeder globen und schwern, was gemaine stat und ein ersamen radt, es sey von des ewangeliums oder in ander weg, angee und anlange, bey einem ersamen radt und desselben mers sten und bleiben, leib und gut dar strecken wolle und nach seinem besten vermogen zu nutz gemainer stat handeln.

Every one shall vow and swear that, in whatsoever concerneth and toucheth the common city and an honourable council, be it of the gospel or in other ways, he will stand and abide by an honourable council and the majority thereof, and will stake body and goods [thereon], and will act to the profit of the common city according to his best ability.

**Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588** (Sehling 13, p. 494):

> Nachmals bekennen sich auch ein erbar cammerer und rate zu den dreien symbolis oder glaubensbekantnussen: nemlich der aposteln, nicenischen und Athanasii, item zu der rainen, unverfelschten augspurgischen confession, wie die keiser Caroln dem fünften auf gehaltenem reichstag zu Augspurg, der wenigern zahl im dreißigsten, überraicht, zu der darüber gestellten apologia, den schmalkaldischen articuln und catechismo des teuren manns Gottes Martini Lutheri, als solchen schriften und bekentnussen, die aus grund Gottes wort gezogen, mit den schriften altes und neues testaments gleichförmig und überainstimmen, inmaßen alle christliche churfürsten und stände augspurgischer confession in rechtem, aigentlichen verstand derselben zugetan, sich sambt ihren kirchen- und schuldienern einhellig und christlich mit herzen, hand und mund bekent und dieselbige underschrieben haben.

Afterwards an honourable chamberlain and council also confess themselves to the three creeds or confessions of faith, namely the Apostles', the Nicene and Athanasius's; item to the pure, unfalsified Augsburg Confession, as it was delivered to the emperor Charles the Fifth at the diet held at Augsburg in the lesser number [of years] in the thirtieth; to the Apology set forth thereupon; to the Smalcald Articles and the catechism of the dear man of God, Martin Luther; as such writings and confessions

as are drawn from the ground of God's word, and agree and accord with the writings of the Old and New Testament; even as all Christian electors and estates of the Augsburg Confession, attached to the same in its right and proper sense, together with their ministers of church and school, have confessed it with one accord and Christianly with heart, hand and mouth, and have subscribed the same.

**Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601** (Reformed; Sehling 14, p. 598). The inspectors are to have the newly chosen elders vow to the published order, which they must first have read or heard read, and so confirm them:

> auch uf diese unsere publicirte ordnung (die sie zuevor entweder gelesen oder lesen gehört sollen haben) angeloben laßen und sie also confirmirn und mit pflichten annehmen sollt.

and ye shall cause them to vow upon this our published ordinance (which they shall before have either read or heard read), and so confirm them and receive them under duty.

The oaths of homage and the prayer for the magistrate are treated in Chapter 13, §13.13, and the magistrate's church duties in Chapter 15, §15.10.

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## 17.18 Table by order

The table lists every order quoted or cited above, grouped by region and in date order within each region. **Norm** gives the documents the order names, in its own sequence. "Scr" is Scripture and "Cr" the three creeds. Qualifiers the order itself uses are in brackets: "unalt." = unaltered or "as delivered in 1530"; "1st ed." = first edition. **Bound** says who is bound. **Form** is the form of binding (§17.4):

- *list*: book list
- *vis.*: visitation question
- *exam*: examination
- *promise*: promise, *Revers* or *Bestallung*
- *oath*: sworn oath
- *vow*: ordination "Yea"
- *sign*: subscription with one's own hand
- *decl.*: declaration of the territory's or the council's confession, no personal form stated

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn* | 1540 | Scr, CA, Apol; *Loci*, Luther's postil | pastors | list | 17.5.1 |
| Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel* | 1557 | Bible, CA, *Repetitio*, agenda, *Loci* | parish, pastor, sexton | list | 17.5.1 |
| Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August | 1580 | Scr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC (as "the Torgau declaration") | every pastor | sign (BoC) | 17.5.3 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction* | 1554 | Bible, Hauspostil, CA, SA, *Unterricht der Visitatoren* | parish | list | 17.6.1 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung … consistorii zu Jena* | 1569 | Scr, Cr, CA (1530), Apol, SA; against Weimar *Confutationes* | consistory members | public confession | 17.6.1 |
| Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung* | 1574/77 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC "*pro norma doctrinae*" | pastors | vis. | 17.6.2 |
| Henneberg, *Kirchenordnung* of Georg Ernst | 1582 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC | ordinands | sign; vow | 17.6.2 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda* | 1580 | Scr, Cr, CA (1st, unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC, Luther's writings, Mansfeld confession 1565 | the county's preachers | decl. | 17.6.3 |
| Mansfeld, *Consistorial ordnung* | 1586 | Bible, Cr, CA, Apol, Luther, catechisms, Mansfeld confession 1565, BoC | consistory | decl. | 17.6.3 |
| Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation* | 1583 | Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC; FC "grounded" on them | pastors | vis. | 17.6.4 |
| Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation* | 1588 | Bible, CA, Apol, SA, catechisms, Brunswick KO's *corpus doctrinae* | pastors | list; vis. | 17.6.5 |
| Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum* | 1588 | Bible, Cr, CA and Apol ("anno 30 und 33"), SA, SC, LC | pastors | list ("*pro confessione*") | 17.6.6 |

**The east: Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities, Pomerania**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff* | 1568 | *Corpus doctrinae Prutenicum* 1567; SC | pastors | decl. | 17.7.2 |
| Prussia, *Consistorialordnung* | 1584 | "our church's unanimous confession" | president, assessors | oath | 17.7.2 |
| Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge* | 1563/69 | Luther's writings; *Loci*, Apol; *Corpus Pomeranicum* | parish, ministers | list | 17.7.4 |
| Pomerania, *Statuta synodica* | 1574 | "pious consensus of heavenly doctrine"; synod statutes, KO, agenda | all ministers | promise (handshake) | 17.7.4 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung* | 1575 | SC, LC, CA (royal privilege) | "teachers and hearers" | decl. | 17.7.3 |
| Danzig, *Decret des Senats* | 1586 | CA and *Notel*; BoC forbidden | preachers | decl. | 17.7.3 |
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1592 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, Luther, *CPhil*, Mecklenburg agenda | preachers | list | 17.7.1 |
| Danzig, *Kirchenordnung* | 1612 | Scr, CA 1530, city *Notel* ("formula concordiae") | preachers | sign (*Notel*) | 17.7.3 |

**The Baltic and Schleswig-Holstein**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1552 | doctrine confessed in the examination | ordinands | promise | 17.8.1 |
| Kurland, *Kirchenordnung* | 1570 | Scr, CA, Apol, Cr, ancient councils, SA, *CPhil* 1560, SC | new preachers | decl. | 17.8.2 |
| Rostock, *Statuta et decreta* | 1573 (1577) | Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, Mecklenburg KO, SC, LC, Luther, Lüneburg Articles, FC | ministerium | sign (FC 1577) | 17.8.1 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid* | 1574 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC (on the Supper) | preachers | oath | 17.8.4 |
| Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1585 | Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, Luther, SC, LC, "or FC" | pastors | promise | 17.8.3 |
| Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid* | 1607 | Scripture only | ordinands | oath | 17.8.4 |

**Lower Saxony**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1564 | Scr, Cr, SC, CA and Apol 1530 | the prince | decl. | 17.9.3 |
| Göttingen, *Kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen* | 1568 | CA 1530, Apol, SA, SC, city KO approved by Luther | council and ministry | decl. | 17.9.4 |
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* | 1569 | Scr, Cr, CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, catechism, Luther | all pastors | decl. | 17.9.1 |
| Brunswick city, *Articuli … subscribendi* | 1571 | Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol 1531, SA, catechisms; against Lüneburg Articles' errors | new ministers | sign | 17.9.2 |
| Brunswick city, *Vokationsordnung* | 1571 | the city's *corpus doctrinae* | new preachers | sign; vow | 17.9.2 |
| Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung* | 1575 | Scr, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, catechisms, Lübeck-Hamburg-Lüneburg confession 1548 | ordinands | written confession, checked | 17.9.3 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung* | 1581 | Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC ("laymen's Bible"), FC | pastors | decl. | 17.9.5 |
| Goslar, *Verzeichnis der … Lehrschriften* | 1591/95 | Scr, Cr, SC, LC, CA 1530, Apol (1st print), SA 1537, Lower Saxon Confession 1571, FC | ministry, schoolmasters | sign | 17.9.6 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied* | 1601 | ducal KO, *Corpus Julium*; town KO | preachers in the four towns | sign | 17.9.4 |

**The north-west**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bremen, *Berufung von Markus Mening* (Philippist) | 1570 | Cr, CA, Apol, *Saxonica*, *CPhil* | preacher | call (*Berufung*) | 17.10.5 |
| Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums* (Philippist) | 1572 | Scr, Cr, CA, *CPhil*, Verden recess | ministry, future ministers | decl. | 17.10.5 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1573 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, catechism, *CPhil* (*Repetitio*, *Loci*, *Examen*, *Responsiones*) | pastors | list | 17.10.4 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Bremen, settlement of the Naso conflict (Philippist) | 1575 | adds the Frankfurt Recess | ministry | decl. | 17.10.5 |
| Peine (Hildesheim), *Eid und obligation der prediger* | 1574/89 | Scr, Cr (Christology), CA, Apol, SA, catechisms | preachers | oath | 17.10.1 |
| Oldenburg, *Bestallungen* | 1574–1608 | CA, catechism, KO; + FC (1586); CA "incorporated in the FC" (1608) | pastors, superintendent | promise | 17.10.4 |
| Soest, *Artikel der Prediger* | 1590 | Bible, Cr, CA 1530, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC | all ministers | sign | 17.10.7 |
| Hildesheim, council decision (in Sehling's introduction) | 1593 | FC and Erfurt Apology | superintendent, burgomasters, syndics, physicians, secretaries, preachers, schoolmasters | sign | 17.10.1 |
| East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung* | 1593 | Scr, Cr, CA (unfalsified), Apol, SC, LC, FC 1580 | pastors | decl. | 17.10.6 |
| East Frisia, *Konkordaten* (Reformed–Lutheran treaty) | 1599 | CA only | the land | treaty | 17.10.6 |
| Verden, *Kirchenordnung* | 1606 | CA "as explained" by Apol, SA, SC, LC | the diocese | decl. | 17.10.2 |
| Oldenburg, visitation articles | 1609 | FC, KO; against Calvinist doctrine | pastors | vis. | 17.10.4 |
| Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung* | 1610 | CA (unalt.) as explained by Apol, Wittenberg Concord 1536, SA, SC, LC, BoC | preachers | decl. | 17.10.3 |
| Hildesheim, *Schulordnung* | 1574/1618 | FC and its Apology | teachers | sign | 17.10.1 |

**Hesse and its neighbours**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener* | 1564 | Scr, Cr, CA, *Loci* | new preachers | promise | 17.11.4 |
| Hesse, *Abschied* (Philippist) | 1571 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, *CPhil* | synod's pastors | decl. | 17.11.1 |
| Hesse, *Agende* (Philippist) | 1574 | Scr (sole *norma iudicii*), Cr, CA ("symbol of our time"); var. + Apol, *CPhil* | pastors | decl. | 17.11.1 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1574/76 | Scr, CA (unalt.) | pastors | vis. | 17.11.5 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung* (Reformed) | 1582 | "the Reformed doctrine" | communicants | confession before Supper | 17.17.2 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung* | 1588 | Scr, Cr, CA (unalt.), Apol, SA, SC, LC | pastors | decl. | 17.11.5 |
| Frankfurt, *Agende* | 1589 | Scr, CA, SA, SC, LC, BoC | ordinands | vow | 17.11.3 |
| Waldeck, revised ordination form | about 1584 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC | ordinands | vow | 17.11.2 |
| Hessen-Kassel, Katzenelnbogen *Diensteid* (Philippist) | 1598 | Scr, Cr, four councils, Leo's Tome, CA, Apol, SA, synodal *Abschiede*; against ubiquity | pastors | oath | 17.11.1 |
| Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der CA* | 1617 | Scr, CA (unalt.); against papists, Zwinglians, Calvinists, Anabaptists | theologians, professors, preachers, schoolmasters | oath | 17.11.1 |

**The Palatinates**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Bestallung* | 1555 | — | pastor | promise ("with fealty given by the hand") | 17.12.1 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich | 1556 | Scr, Cr, CA and Apol 1530 ("unfalsified sense"), SA, Luther's catechism | pastors | decl. | 17.12.1 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten* | 1564 | Scr, CA, Apol, Wittenberg Concord 1536, SA, KO | ministers | decl. | 17.12.3 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung* | 1564 | Scr, four creeds (incl. Te Deum), four councils, CA 1530, SA, … | ministers | sign ("*mente atque manu*") | 17.12.4 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel* | 1576 | Scr, Cr, CA 1530 ("symbol of our time"), Apol, SA, SC = *corpus doctrinae* | pastors | decl. | 17.12.3 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung* | 1580 | Luther's catechism, CA, Apol, BoC | ministers | promise | 17.12.1 |
| Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion* (Reformed) | 1585 | Scr, Cr, four councils, CA and Apol as repeated at Frankfurt and Naumburg; release from BoC | church council; ministers | decl. | 17.12.2 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung* (Reformed) | 1586 | Heidelberg Catechism (large and small), CA, Apol | ministers | promise | 17.12.1 |
| Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung* (Reformed) | 1601 | (the *Bestallung*) | schoolmasters | promise "in the stead of an oath"; sign | 17.12.1 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel* | 1608 | FC "*pro symbolo*" | pastors | list; written declaration | 17.12.5 |

**Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung* | 1547 | CA, Apol, later *Loci* | preachers | exam | 17.13.1 |
| Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener* | after 1559 | Scr, CA, Württemberg Confession | ministers | oath | 17.13.1 |
| Ulm, *Anweisungen für Amtsträger* | 1567 | CA, Apol, Ulm Supper confession | pastors | decl. | 17.13.4 |
| Württemberg, FC mandate | 1577 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, Württemberg Confession, SA, SC, FC | all theologians, ministers of church and school | sign | 17.13.2 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung* | 1578 | Scr (*norma iudicii*), Cr, CA, …; + FC (by hand) | "teachers and hearers" | decl. | 17.13.3 |
| Ravensburg, local "formula concordiae" | 1578/1617 | local preachers' concord | preachers | sign | 17.13.5 |
| Wimpfen, *Notula subscriptionis* | after 1577 | CA 1530, FC | clergy | oath; sign | 17.13.5 |
| Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* (apparatus) | 1581 | Scr, Cr, CA 1530 only | — | decl. | 17.13.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener* | 1588 | the county KO | ministers | oath | 17.13.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge* | 1609–15 | CA 1530; *Gründlicher Bericht* 1605 | ministers, teachers | sign; oath; *Revers* | 17.13.3 |
| Limpurg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1610 | CA, FC | ministers | sign | 17.13.2 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, *Kirchenordnung* | 1614/15 | BoC, city KO | ordinands | sign | 17.13.5 |

**Franconia and Regensburg**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid* | 1528 | "the holy gospel and word of God" | pastors | oath; sign | 17.14.1 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1567? | CA ("true sense"), Apol 1530, SA 1537, Luther; against named sects | ministers | exam question | 17.14.3 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid* (variant) | 1570–88 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, local formula of 1570 | pastors | oath | 17.14.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach and Nürnberg, *norma doctrinae* | 1573 | Cr, SC, LC, CA (last and 1st ed.), Apol, SA, *Repetitio*, *Loci*, | all clergy | oath; sign | 17.14.1–17.14.2 |

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| | | *Examen*, *Responsiones*, Brandenburg KO; + BoC (1577) | | | |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung* | 1572/88 | Cr, CA (unfalsified), Apol, SA, SC; BoC | council (decl.); every minister and schoolmaster | sign | 17.14.3, 17.17.5 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Priestereid* (variant) | from 1588 | Scr, Cr, CA, Apol, SA, SC, LC, FC 1580, KO | pastors | oath | 17.14.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach, *Konsistorialordnung* | 1594 | BoC and KO "as our *corpus doctrinae*" | candidates; assessors | exam; oath | 17.14.1 |

**Strasbourg, Alsace, Transylvania**

| Order | Date | Norm | Bound | Form | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, *Examensordnung* | 1549 | CA | candidates | exam | 17.15.1 |
| Strasbourg, council decree (in *Gottesdienstordnung* 1577) | 1562 | CA, Apol (as at Naumburg) | ministers | public confession; "*stipulata manu*" | 17.15.2 |
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung* | 1577 | FC | ministers | sign ("*corde et manu*") | 17.15.2 |
| Burzenland chapter | 1573 | CA | new ministers | oath | 17.16 |
| Colmar, *Eid der Prediger* | 1575 | Scr, Fathers, CA, Apol | preachers | oath | 17.15.3 |
| Colmar, refusal of the FC (Moderate Reformed) | 1578 | — | — | — | 17.15.3 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung* | 1598 | Scr, Apostles' Creed, four councils, CA, Apol 1530, FC 1580 | ordinands | vow | 17.15.2 |
| Transylvanian Saxons, *Superintendentenwahl* | 1601 | Scr, CA, SA, ecumenical creeds | superintendent | oath | 17.16 |

**The laity**

| Order | Date | What is required | Of whom | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Ziegenhain *Zuchtordnung*; Kassel KO (Hesse; Moderate Reformed) | 1539 | catechism examination, self-surrender to Christ and the church, vow to remain in the fellowship and accept discipline | confirmands | 17.17.1 |
| Heilbronn, council oath | 1530 | to stand by the council "in the matter of the gospel" | councillors | 17.17.5 |
| Schweinfurt, KO | 1543 | announcement and exploration before communion, per CA and Apol | communicants | 17.17.2 |
| Baden, Anabaptist mandate (var. C) | 1543 | proof of not belonging to the sect | new burghers | 17.17.3 |
| Strasbourg, Marbach KO | 1553 | confession and submission to discipline | confirmands | 17.17.1 |
| Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung* | 1557 | private admonition of sectarian abstainers | non-communicants | 17.17.2 |

| Order | Date | What is required | Of whom | § |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Wied, synod (Reformed) | 1564 | examination of godparents of another religion | godparents | 17.17.4 |
| Micron's *Ordinancien* (Reformed) | 1554/1565 | catechism answers, vow of constancy, submission to discipline | confirmands | 17.17.1 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel* | 1576 | catechism before first communion; six chief parts before marriage | the young, bridal couples | 17.17.2 |
| Electoral Saxony, KO | 1580 | catechism examination as "confirmation" of the baptismal faith | children | 17.17.1 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, KO (Reformed) | 1582 | confession of the Reformed doctrine | communicants, strangers | 17.17.2 |
| Soest | 1583 | godparents of both religions admitted | godparents | 17.17.4 |
| Hildesheim | 1593 | signature to FC and Erfurt Apology | city officials | 17.10.1 |
| Kurpfalz, mandate (Reformed) | 1599 | recite the chief parts | bridal couples; new burghers | 17.17.3 |
| Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung* (Reformed) | about 1601 | vow to the order | elders | 17.17.5 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte* | 1609 | heterodox godparents admitted with discretion | godparents | 17.17.4 |
| Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung* | 1611 | heterodox godparents excluded | godparents | 17.17.4 |

## 17.19 Concordance of the orders quoted

Every order quoted in this chapter is listed below by region, in the order in which it is quoted. The table gives:

- **Sehling**: the volume and pages in Sehling's edition.
- **Doc**: the `eko.db` document that holds the text, for full-text lookup. A single database record may hold several orders.
- **§**: the sections where the order is quoted.

**Saxony, Thuringia and central Germany**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Albertine Saxony, *Gemeiner bericht der visitatorn an die pfarrer und dorfschaften*, 1540 | 1, p. 285 | 32 | 17.5.1 |
| Albertine Saxony, *General-Artikel und gemeiner Bericht*, 8 May 1557 | 1, p. 325 | 37 | 17.5.1 |
| Electoral Saxony, *Kirchenordnung* of Elector August, 1580 | 1, pp. 380, 420, 425 | 44 | 17.5.3, 17.17.1 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Instruction Johans Friderichen des mittlern, Johans Wilhelm und Johans Friderichen d. j.*, 1554 | 1, p. 227 | 21 | 17.6.1 |
| Ernestine Saxony, *Ordnung und reformation ecclesiastici consistorii zu Jena*, 1569 | 1, p. 234 | 24 | 17.6.1 |
| Henneberg, *Visitations- und Consistorial-Ordnung*, 1574, 1577 | 2, p. 291 | 1247 | 17.6.2 |
| Henneberg, *Des durchlauchtigen hochgebornen fürsten und herrn, herrn Georg Ernsten, kirchen ordnung*, 1582 | 2, pp. 300, 324 | 1247 | 17.6.2 |
| Mansfeld, *Kirchen-agenda für die prediger der grafschaft Mansfeld*, 1580 | 2, p. 215 | 1241 | 17.6.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mansfeld, *Gräflich mansfeldische geistliche consistorial ordnung*, 1586 | 2, p. 201 | 1240 | 17.6.3 |
| Archbishopric of Magdeburg, *Instruktion zur Visitation*, 25 May 1583 | 2, p. 419 | 1256 | 17.6.4 |
| Bishopric of Halberstadt, *Instruktion für die Visitation*, 8 August 1588 | 2, pp. 468–469 | 1259 | 17.6.5 |
| Anhalt, *Instructio commissariorum in potestate executionis der vorgenommenen Visitation*, 21 September 1588 | 2, p. 579 | 1262 | 17.6.6 |

**Silesia, Prussia, the Polish cities and Pomerania**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592 | 3, pp. 444–445 | 1809 | 17.7.1 |
| Brieg, *Kirchenordnung für Brieg*, 1592 (chapter *De corpore doctrinae*) | 3, p. 448 | 1810 | 17.7.1 |
| Prussia, *Von Erwehlung der beiden bischoff*, 1568 | 4, p. 111 | 1833 | 17.7.2 |
| Prussia, *Consistorialordnung*, 1584 | 4, p. 125 | 1834 | 17.7.2 |
| Thorn, *Kirchenordnung für Thorn*, 1575 | 4, p. 234 | 1844 | 17.7.3 |
| Danzig, *Decret des Senats*, 23 October 1586 | 4, p. 192 | 1844 | 17.7.3 |
| Danzig, *Kirchenordnung für Danzig*, 1612 | 4, p. 210 | 1844 | 17.7.3 |
| Pomerania, *Kerckenordeninge*, 1569 | 4, p. 382 | 1862 | 17.7.4 |
| Pomerania, *Statuta synodica*, 1574 | 4, p. 492 | 1868 | 17.7.4 |

**Mecklenburg, Kurland, Lauenburg and Schleswig-Holstein**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mecklenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1552 | 5, p. 192 | 1922 | 17.8.1 |
| Rostock, *Statuta et decreta*, 1573 | 5, p. 285 | 1934 | 17.8.1 |
| Kurland, *Kurländische Kirchenordnung*, 1570 | 5, p. 70 | 1907 | 17.8.2 |
| Lauenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1585 | 5, p. 402 | 1953 | 17.8.3 |
| Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Predigereid*, 1574 | 23, p. 365 | 1619 | 17.8.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Mitteilung über den Erlaß eines neuen Predigereides*, 4 January 1607 | 23, p. 415 | 1628 | 17.8.4 |
| Schleswig-Holstein-Gottorp, *Neuer Predigereid*, 4 January 1607 | 23, p. 416 | 1628 | 17.8.4 |

**Lower Saxony**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Braunschweig-Wolfenbüttel, *Kirchenordnung* of Duke Julius, 1569 | 6/1, pp. 91–92 | 1974 | 17.9.1 |
| Brunswick, *Articuli, qui subscribendi proponuntur illis qui ad ministerium in hac ecclesia recipiuntur*, 1571 | 6/1, p. 471 | 1987 | 17.9.2 |
| Brunswick, *Vokationsordnung für die Prediger*, 1571 | 6/1, p. 457 | 1985 | 17.9.2 |
| Principality of Lüneburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1564 | 6/1, p. 534 | 2003 | 17.9.3 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Lüneburg city, *Kirchenordnung der Stadt Lüneburg*, 1575 | 6/1, p. 654 | 2017 | 17.9.3 |
| Calenberg-Göttingen, *Gandersheimer Landtagsabschied*, 1601 | 6/2, p. 894 | 2042 | 17.9.4 |
| Göttingen, *Christliche und in Gottes wort … gegründte kirchenordnung der stadt Göttingen*, 1568 | 6/2, p. 916 | 2044 | 17.9.4 |
| Hoya, *Kirchenordnung*, 1581 | 6/2, p. 1131 | 2064 | 17.9.5 |
| Goslar, *Verzeichnis der in Goslar gültigen Lehrschriften*, 11 May 1595 | 7/2.2, pp. 339–340 | 2208 | 17.9.6 |

**The north-west**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Peine, *Eid und obligation der prediger im herzogtumb Schleswiegk wie auch in ihren fürstl. gn. pfandgericht und ampt Peina*, [1574/89] | 7/2.1, p. 787 | 2130 | 17.10.1 |
| Hildesheim, council decision on the subscription of the *Formula Concordiae*, 30 August 1593, quoted in Sehling's introduction | 7/2.1, p. 817 | 2133 | 17.10.1 |
| Hildesheim, *Schulordnung*, 1574/1618 | 7/2.1, p. 909 | 2138 | 17.10.1 |
| Bishopric of Verden, *Kirchenordnung*, 1606 | 7/1, p. 149 | 2088 | 17.10.2 |
| Osnabrück, *Superintendenten- und Predigerordnung*, 1610 | 7/1, pp. 296–297 | 2102 | 17.10.3 |
| Oldenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1573 | 7/2.1, pp. 987–988 | 2147 | 17.10.4 |
| Oldenburg, *Bestallung* of Superintendent Gottfried Schlüter, 1608, quoted in Sehling's apparatus | 7/2.1, p. 964 | 2142 | 17.10.4 |
| Bremen, *Einigung des geistlichen Ministeriums über die in Bremen gültige Lehre*, 1572 (Philippist) | 7/2.2, p. 548 | 2226 | 17.10.5 |
| East Frisia, *Marienhafer Kirchenordnung*, 1593 | 7/1, p. 684 | 2119 | 17.10.6 |
| East Frisia, *Die Konkordaten*, 1599 (Reformed–Lutheran treaty) | 7/1, p. 421 | 2110 | 17.10.6 |
| Soest, *Artikel der Prediger*, 1 September 1590 | 22, p. 480 | 1536 | 17.10.7 |

**Hesse and its neighbours**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse, *Abschied* of the general synod, 1571 (Philippist) | 8, p. 355 | 2263 | 17.11.1 |
| Hesse, *Agende*, 1574 (Philippist) | 8, p. 415 | 2272 | 17.11.1 |
| Hessen-Kassel, *Diensteid der Pfarrer in der Niedergrafschaft Katzenelnbogen*, 20 February 1598 (Philippist) | 9, p. 54 | 2287 | 17.11.1 |
| Hessen-Darmstadt, *Mandat zur Beibehaltung der Confessio Augustana*, 28 July 1617 | 9, p. 152 | 2287 | 17.11.1 |
| Waldeck, *Kirchenordnung* 1556, ordination form in the revision of about 1584 | 9, p. 292 | 2300 | 17.11.2 |
| Frankfurt, *Agende*, 1589 | 9, p. 541 | 2332 | 17.11.3 |
| Nassau-Diez, *Revers der Kirchendiener*, [1564] | 10, p. 103 | 177 | 17.11.4 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1574/1576 | 10, p. 306 | 198 | 17.11.5 |
| Ysenburg-Birstein, *Kirchenordnung*, 1588 | 10, p. 619 | 228 | 17.11.5 |

**The Palatinates**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchenordnung* of Ottheinrich, 1556 | 14, pp. 114–115 | 476 | 17.12.1 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1580 | 14, p. 507 | 505 | 17.12.1 |
| Kurpfalz, *Kirchendienerbestallung*, 1586 (Reformed) | 14, p. 525 | 509 | 17.12.1 |
| Kurpfalz, *Schuldienerbestallung*, 1601 (Reformed) | 14, p. 593 | 517 | 17.12.1 |
| Upper Palatinate, *Kirchenratsinstruktion*, 3 March 1585 (Reformed) | 13, pp. 328–329 | 420 | 17.12.2 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Mandat gegen die Kalvinisten*, 1564 | 13, p. 148 | 401 | 17.12.3 |
| Pfalz-Neuburg, *Generalartikel*, 1576 | 13, pp. 171, 176 | 404 | 17.12.3, 17.17.2 |
| Pfalz-Zweibrücken, *Bekenntnisverpflichtung der Kirchendiener*, 1564 | 18, pp. 328–329 | 982 | 17.12.4 |
| Hintere Grafschaft Sponheim, *Generalartikel*, 1608 | 18, p. 671 | 1021 | 17.12.5 |

**Württemberg, Hohenlohe and Swabia**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1547 | 16, p. 155 | 659 | 17.13.1 |
| Württemberg, *Eid der Kirchendiener*, [after 1559] | 16, p. 424 | 685 | 17.13.1 |
| Württemberg, *Mandat zur Unterzeichnung der Konkordienformel*, 1577 | 16, p. 445 | 692 | 17.13.2 |
| Hohenlohe, *Kirchenordnung*, 1578 | 15, p. 260 | 574 | 17.13.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Verzeichnis* of 4 November 1581, quoted in the apparatus to the *Kirchenordnung* of 1578 | 15, p. 261 | 574 | 17.13.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Eid der gemeinsamen Kirchendiener*, 1588 | 15, p. 562 | 608 | 17.13.3 |
| Hohenlohe, *Erb- und Teilungsverträge*, 1609–1615 | 15, p. 674 | 633 | 17.13.3 |
| Schwäbisch Hall, ordination, *Kirchenordnung* 1614/15 | 17/1, p. 184 | 763 | 17.13.5 |
| Wimpfen, *Eid und Pflichten der Geistlichen*, [after 1577] | 17/2, p. 530 | 930 | 17.13.5 |
| Ravensburg, *Konkordie und Kirchenordnung*, 28 January 1578, renewal of 1617 | 17/2, p. 500 | 922 | 17.13.5 |

**Franconia and Regensburg**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Der evangelische Priestereid*, 1528 | 11, pp. 107, 109 | 264 | 17.14.1 |
| Brandenburg-Ansbach-Kulmbach, *Konsistorialordnung*, 1594 | 11, p. 388 | 291 | 17.14.1 |

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Regensburg, *Kirchenordnung* (of 1567?) | 13, p. 453 | 450 | 17.14.3 |
| Regensburg, *Kirchenregimentsordnung*, 1572/1588 | 13, pp. 494–495 | 452 | 17.14.3, 17.17.5 |

**Strasbourg, Alsace and Transylvania**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Strasbourg, *Examensordnung*, 1549 (under the Interim) | 20/1, p. 365 | 1318 | 17.15.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Gottesdienstordnung*, [after August 1577] | 20/1, p. 512 | 1336 | 17.15.2 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung*, 9 April 1598 | 20/1, pp. 640–641 | 1344 | 17.15.2 |
| Colmar, *Eid der Prediger*, 22 October 1575 | 20/2, p. 501 | 1408 | 17.15.3 |
| Colmar, *Ablehnung des Beitritts zur Konkordienformel*, 10 May 1578 (Moderate Reformed) | 20/2, p. 509 | 1408 | 17.15.3 |
| Burzenland, *Beschlüsse des Burzenländer Kapitels zum Eid auf die Confessio Augustana*, 1573 | 24, p. 371 | 1694 | 17.16 |
| Transylvanian Saxons, *Ordnung der Superintendentenwahl*, 1601 | 24, p. 480 | 1722 | 17.16 |

**The laity (§17.17)**

| Order | Sehling | Doc | § |
|---|---|---|---|
| Hesse, *Ziegenhainer Zuchtordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 104 | 2252 | 17.17.1 |
| Hesse, *Kasseler Kirchenordnung*, 1539 (Moderate Reformed) | 8, p. 125 | 2253 | 17.17.1 |
| Strasbourg, *Kirchenordnung von Johannes Marbach*, 1553 | 20/1, p. 396 | 1321 | 17.17.1 |
| East Frisia (Reformed), *Microns Ordinancien* (1554), 1565 | 7/1, p. 607 | 2116 | 17.17.1 |
| Schweinfurt, *Kirchenordnung*, 1543 | 11, p. 640 | 304 | 17.17.2 |
| Württemberg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1557 | 16, p. 331 | 682 | 17.17.2 |
| Nassau-Dillenburg, *Kirchenordnung*, 1582 (Reformed) | 10, p. 163 | 184 | 17.17.2 |
| Kurpfalz, *Mandat zum Katechismusunterricht*, 1 February 1599 (Reformed) | 19/2, p. 890 | 1175 | 17.17.3 |
| Baden, *Wiedertäufermandat*, 1543, version C | 16, p. 515 | 704 | 17.17.3 |
| Limpurg, *Visitationsordnung*, 1611 | 16, p. 629 | 730 | 17.17.4 |
| Wied, *Synodalbeschlüsse*, 5 June 1564 (Reformed) | 19/1, p. 466 | 1094 | 17.17.4 |
| Nassau-Weilburg, *Erläuterungspunkte zur Kirchenordnung*, 1609 | 10, p. 329 | 198 | 17.17.4 |
| Soest, *Anweisung zu den Taufpaten*, 8 June 1583 | 22, p. 478 | 1534 | 17.17.4 |
| Heilbronn, *Eid des Heilbronner Rates auf den neuen Glauben*, 18 November 1530 | 17/1, p. 290 | 771 | 17.17.5 |
| Kurpfalz, *Presbyterordnung*, about 1601 (Reformed) | 14, p. 598 | 518 | 17.17.5 |

# Scripture index

This index lists the passages of Scripture that the book cites by book and chapter: in its own text, in the orders it quotes and in the translations. Each passage is followed by the sections that cite it, and each section number is a link. A section that cites a passage more than once is listed once, and a reference to a whole chapter is listed apart from references to its verses. A reference in the opening pages of a chapter, before its first section, is listed under the chapter.

Books are named and psalms numbered as in the Authorized Version, with the Apocrypha between the Testaments. Where an order numbers a psalm as the Vulgate does, as "the 42nd psalm" for *Iudica me*, the passage is listed under its English number. Texts named only by their titles, such as the Magnificat or the Aaronic blessing, are not indexed unless a chapter is given.

**Old Testament:** Genesis · Exodus · Leviticus · Numbers · Deuteronomy · 1 Samuel · 2 Kings · 2 Chronicles · Psalms · Proverbs · Isaiah · Ezekiel

**Apocrypha:** Tobit

**New Testament:** Matthew · Mark · Luke · John · Acts · Romans · 1 Corinthians · 2 Corinthians · Galatians · Ephesians · Philippians · Colossians · 1 Thessalonians · 1 Timothy · 2 Timothy · Titus · Hebrews · James · 1 Peter · 1 John

### Genesis

- 1 — 13.7.2, 13.15.1
- 1:27–28 — 13.7.1
- 1:31 — 13.7.1
- 2 — 13.7.2, 13.7.3
- 2:18 — 13.7.1
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- Zwick, Johannes — 1.3.3, 1.25.3
- Zwingli, Huldrych — 17.7.3

# Glossary

This glossary explains the rarer terms of liturgy, church order and church life that the book uses, in English, German and Latin. Where the book treats a term at length, the entry ends with a link to that section. The usual English renderings of the orders' German terms are listed under Translations in the Conventions, and the traditions and the abbreviations under Traditions and the Interim and Abbreviations. They are not repeated here.

A · B · C · D · E · F · G · H · I · K · L · M · N · O · P · Q · R · S · T · U · V · W

**A**

- **accessus** (Latin). The priest's private preparation for Mass, an office of psalms and prayers said before he went to the altar. Several orders recast it as the congregation's *Veni Sancte Spiritus* before the introit. See §3.3.1, §3.3.7.
- **acolyte**. The highest of the four minor orders, who carried the candles and served the wine and water at the altar. Only the Bohemian Brethren kept acolytes. See §16.3.4, and *minor orders*.
- **acted ceremonies**. The dramatic ceremonies of the medieval year: the Palm Sunday ass (*Palmesel*), the Good Friday grave, the Easter image, the Ascension figure, the Whitsun dove and the rocking of the Christmas cradle (*Kindelwiegen*). The orders abolished them. See §12.10.10.
- **adiaphora** (Greek). "Things indifferent": ceremonies neither commanded nor forbidden by God, which a church may keep or drop for good order. The orders treat vestments, images and many ceremonies as such. See §14.3.
- **Adiutorium** (Latin). The versicle *Adiutorium nostrum in nomine Domini*, "Our help is in the name of the Lord", which opened the priest's preparation and many offices. It is the one opening versicle that survives widely in the evangelical orders. See §3.3.1.
- **Agende** (German; also *Agenda*, *Agendbüchlein*). The service book of a church: the forms for the Mass, baptism, marriage, burial and the other rites, printed with the church order or apart from it. See §1.2.4.
- **alb** (Latin *alba*). The long white linen tunic worn under the other vestments. See §14.7.1.
- **alternatim** (Latin). Performance in alternation: the organ takes a verse or stanza in turn with the choir or the people, and the verse it takes is played, not sung. See §9.3.3.
- **amice** (Latin *amictus*). The linen cloth put on round the neck before the alb.
- **Amt** (German). (1) The service, above all the communion service (*das Amt*, *Hochamt*). (2) A district of a territory under the prince's officer, the *Amtmann*, as "Amt Wittenberg".
- **Anabaptists**. The radical movement that rejected infant baptism and baptized believers. The orders proceed against it, save the Münster council's mandate of 1534, which tolerated it. See §1.3.6.
- **angelicum** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **antiphon**. A short sung text, usually from Scripture, sung before and after a psalm or canticle in the office, or on its own.
- **antiphoner**. The choir book of the chants of the office: antiphons, responsories and hymns. The Lutheran antiphoners of Spangenberg (1545) and Lossius (1553) purged and reprinted the old chant. See §10.9.2.
- **Auctuarium** (Latin). The *Mehrung der vorigen Kirchenordnung* of Brandenburg-Ansbach (1548), the adaptation of its church order to the Interim, and one of the Interim orders in the set. See §1.4.
- **Aufer a nobis** (Latin). "Take away from us [our iniquities]": the prayer the priest said as he went up to the altar after the *Confiteor*. It survives in German in Müntzer's Allstedt Mass, and in Latin after the sermon in the *Cellische Ordnungen* of 1545. See §3.3.1, §3.3.8.

**B**

- **ban** (German *Bann*). Church discipline by exclusion: the lesser ban kept a sinner from the Lord's Supper, the greater ban (*excommunicatio maior*) from the fellowship of the church. See §13.16.1.
- **banns**. The public announcement of an intended marriage in church, so that any impediment might be declared. See §13.7.5.
- **Begängnis** (German). A memorial service for the dead on the seventh or thirtieth day or the anniversary, abolished with the soul-Masses. See §13.9.1.
- **Beichtgeld** (German). Confession-money: the offering given to the confessor at private confession. See §13.17.4.
- **Benedicamus** (Latin). The versicle *Benedicamus Domino*, "Let us bless the Lord", answered *Deo gratias*, which closes the office and, on days without a Gloria, the Mass. The orders kept it, sang it to melodies graded by feast, and put it into German. See §2.13.1, §8.16.8.

- **Benedictus** (Latin). (1) The Song of Zechariah, the canticle of Lauds. (2) *Benedictus qui venit*, "Blessed is he that cometh", which follows the Sanctus. See §2.10.3, §8.4.3.
- **benefice**. A church office with an endowed income, such as a canonry, a vicarage or an altar, held on condition of saying Mass or the hours. See §10.6.2.
- **Bestallung** (German). A letter of appointment for a church officer, such as a preacher, schoolmaster, organist or bell-ringer, setting out his duties and wages. He answered it with a *Revers*. See §13.12.2.
- **betrothal** (German *Verlöbnis*, *Eheversprechen*). The binding promise of marriage, given before witnesses. Only the consistory or the marriage court could release it. See §13.7.8, §13.7.9.
- **Bittherren** (German). The twelve lay collectors (*subdiaconi*) of St Wenzel's at Naumburg, chosen from the council and the community, who stood at the church doors with collecting boards. See §16.5.2.
- **Brautpredigt** (German; also *Hochzeitpredigt*). The wedding sermon. See §11.4.7.

**C**

- **Candlemas**. The feast of the Purification of Mary, 2 February, with the blessing of candles. See §12.8.1.
- **Canon** (Latin). The fixed prayer of the Roman Mass between the Sanctus and the Lord's Prayer, said quietly by the priest, with the Words of Institution at its centre. Its prayers are named by their first words, from *Te igitur* to the closing doxology *Per ipsum*. The evangelical orders dropped it or kept only fragments. See Chapter 7.
- **canon minor** (Latin). "The lesser canon": the offertory prayers, as distinct from the Canon proper, the *canon maior*. The evangelical orders dropped both. See §4.7.1.
- **canonical hours**. The daily round of offices of the medieval church: Matins, Lauds, Prime, Terce, Sext, None, Vespers and Compline. See §10.5.1.
- **canticle**. A song of Scripture other than a psalm, sung in the office: the *Benedictus* at Lauds, the *Magnificat* at Vespers, the *Nunc dimittis* at Compline, and the Old Testament canticles such as the *Benedicite*.
- **cantional**. A school and choir book of the Latin and German chants of the year. Several orders required the cantionals of Spangenberg and Lossius. See §8.18.6.
- **cantor**. The master of the choir, usually a schoolmaster, who led the singing of the scholars at Mass and office. See §13.12.3.
- **ceroferarius** (Latin; also *accensor*). The candle-bearer, who carried a candle at the gospel and in processions. See §16.4.4.
- **chasuble** (German *Meßgewand*, *Casel*). The priest's outer vestment at Mass, a wide mantle without sleeves. Many Lutheran orders kept it; the Reformed abolished it. See §14.7.1.
- **choraliter** (Latin). Sung in plainsong, as against *figuraliter*, in figured music. See §4.10.4.
- **chrism**. The consecrated mixture of olive oil and balsam used at baptism, confirmation and ordination. The plainer *oil of catechumens* was used before baptism. Only two evangelical orders kept the chrism. See §13.15.4.
- **churching** (German *Kirchgang*, *Aussegnung*). A mother's return to church after childbirth, at the end of her six weeks. In the orders it is a thanksgiving, not a purification. See §13.5.
- **ciborium**. A covered vessel for the consecrated hosts kept in reserve. See §14.6.7.
- **collect** (Latin *collecta*). The short prayer of the day, said by the priest before the epistle after "Let us pray". See Chapter 5.
- **collegiate church**. A church served by a chapter of canons, who sang the hours in choir. See §10.4.2.
- **commixture**. The dropping of a particle of the host into the chalice after the fraction, with the prayer *Haec commixtio*. See §7.6.11.
- **commune sanctorum** (Latin). "The common of saints": the propers shared by all the saints of one kind, such as apostles, martyrs or virgins, used where a saint had none of his own. See §12.4.4.
- **Communicantes** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that joins the Church's offering to the memory of the Virgin, the apostles and the martyrs. See §7.6.4, and *Canon*.
- **communio** (Latin). The communion chant: an antiphon sung during or after the distribution. See §4.9.
- **complenda** (Latin). The old name of the prayer after communion, the postcommunion. Several orders still gave it to Luther's thanksgiving. See §5.6.3.
- **Compline** (Latin *completorium*, German *Complet*). The last office of the day, said before sleep. See Chapter 10.
- **confirmation** (German *Firmung*). In the medieval church a sacrament given by the bishop with chrism; in the evangelical orders an examination in the catechism, with profession, prayer and the laying on of hands, before first communion. See §13.6.
- **Confiteor** (Latin). "I confess to Almighty God": the confession of sins said by the priest and his ministers at the foot of the altar, answered by the *Misereatur* and the *Indulgentiam*. See §3.3.2.

- **confraternity** (German *Bruderschaft*). A brotherhood of lay people for devotion, Masses for the dead and the keeping of an altar. The orders dissolved them into the common chest. See §16.7.6.
- **consistory** (German *Konsistorium*). The territorial church court and board of theologians and jurists, which examined ministers, judged marriage cases and kept discipline. See §15.5.
- **convent**. (1) A religious house of monks or nuns. (2) A meeting of the clergy of a district for study and mutual correction. See §10.4.4, §15.7.5.
- **cope** (German *Chorkappe*, *Chormantel*). A long cloak open at the front, worn in processions, at the office and at services without communion. See §14.7.2.
- **corporal**. The square linen cloth spread on the altar under the chalice and the host. See §14.6.2.
- **Corpus Christi**. The feast of the Body of Christ on the Thursday after Trinity Sunday, with its procession of the sacrament. Most evangelical orders abolished it. See §12.8.9.
- **corpus doctrinae** (Latin). "A body of doctrine": the collection of confessions that a church declared to be its standard of teaching, as the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum* (1560). See §17.3.
- **Corpus tuum** (Latin). The priest's prayer after communion, "Thy body, O Lord, which I have received", which Luther kept as a postcommunion in 1523. See §5.6.1.

**D**

- **dalmatic**, **tunicle**. The outer vestments of the deacon and subdeacon at a solemn Mass. See §14.2.3.
- **de tempore** (Latin). "Of the season": the propers, lessons and hymns of the Sundays and feasts of the church year, as against those *de sanctis*, of the saints' days. See §12.4.4.
- **deacons of the poor** (Latin *diaconi pauperum*). Laymen chosen to collect and give out the alms. In the Lutheran orders they were often the managers of the common chest. See §16.5.2.
- **dean** (Latin *decanus*). A minister set over the pastors of a district under the superintendent; in Transylvania the head of a chapter. See §15.4.
- **Deutsche Messe** (German). Luther's German Mass of 1526, written for the parishes, and with the *Formula missae* one of the two baselines of the evangelical Mass. See §2.3.3.
- **Diaconus** (Latin; German *Helfer*, *Kaplan*, *Capellan*). In the Lutheran orders the assistant minister of a parish, an ordained preacher under the pastor, not the deacon of the medieval Mass. See §16.5.1.
- **dominicale** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **Dominus vobiscum** (Latin). "The Lord be with you", the priest's salutation, answered *Et cum spiritu tuo*, "And with thy spirit", before the collect, the Preface and the blessing. See §2.8.
- **duplex**, **semiduplex**, **simplex** (Latin). Grades of feast in the medieval calendar, with *totum duplex* and *summum* above them, which decided how the office and Mass of the day were kept. The evangelical orders do not use them. See §12.4.1.

**E**

- **early sermon** (German *Frühpredigt*). The first sermon of a Sunday or feast, preached early in the morning before the Mass.
- **Easter sepulchre**. The "Good Friday grave", in which the host or the crucifix was laid from Good Friday until Easter morning. The orders abolished it. See §13.20.4, and *acted ceremonies*.
- **elevation**. The lifting up of the consecrated host and chalice after the Words of Institution, for the people to see. Many Lutheran orders kept it for a time, often with a bell or a hymn. See §2.11, §8.12.3.
- **Ember days** (German *Quatember*, *Fronfasten*). The fast days of the four seasons: the Wednesday, Friday and Saturday after the first Sunday in Lent, after Whitsunday, after Holy Cross Day and after St Lucy's Day. The orders keep them not as fasts but as the four quarter days of the church year, for payments and for preaching the catechism. See §12.12.7.
- **embolism**. The prayer *Libera nos* ("Deliver us, we beseech thee, O Lord"), which takes up the last petition of the Lord's Prayer in the Mass. See §7.6.10.
- **emergency baptism** (German *Nottaufe*, *Jähtaufe*). Baptism given at home by the midwife or another lay person when a newborn child was in danger of death. See §13.3.7.
- **Et in terra** (Latin). The Gloria in excelsis from its second clause, "And on earth peace", which the choir takes up after the priest has intoned *Gloria in excelsis Deo*. See §2.7.2.
- **examen** (Latin; German *Verhör*). An examination: of candidates before ordination, of children in the catechism, of communicants before the Supper. See §15.7.3, §13.17.4.

- **exhortation** (German *Vermahnung*). A set address to the people, above all the exhortation to the communicants before the Supper. See §3.5.
- **exorcism**. The command to the devil at baptism to come out of the child, as in Luther's "Fahr aus, du unreiner Geist". It was kept and defended, and later in the century disputed and in places dropped. See §13.4.
- **extreme unction**. The anointing of the dying with oil. No evangelical order prescribes it: the Word, the absolution, the Supper and prayer take its place. See §13.8.1.

**F**

- **farsed** (also *farced* or *troped*). Of a chant: interlaced with added words. A farsed Kyrie or sequence alternates its Latin with Latin verses or German stanzas. See §8.6.4, §8.8.3.
- **Fastnacht** (German). Shrovetide, the carnival before Lent, with its mumming and dancing, which the orders forbade as heathen. See §12.11.4.
- **festive**, **ferialiter**, **dominicaliter**, **solenniter** (Latin). "In festal, weekday, Sunday or solemn manner": rubrics for the grade of chant and ceremony on a given day. See §12.4.5.
- **festum fori**, **festum chori** (Latin). A feast "of the court", on which work was forbidden, and a feast "of the choir", kept only in the liturgy. See §12.4.
- **figured music** (Latin *figuraliter*, *in mensuris*; German *figurieren*). Polyphony written in measured notes, as against plainsong. See §10.9.4, §12.10.5.
- **Flectamus genua** (Latin). "Let us bend the knee", the bidding before each of the Good Friday solemn prayers, answered *Levate*, "Arise". See §13.22.6.
- **Formula missae** (Latin). Luther's Latin order of the Mass of 1523, the *Formula missae et communionis*, and with the *Deutsche Messe* one of the two baselines of the evangelical Mass. See §2.3.2.
- **fraction**. The breaking of the host before communion. See §7.6.11.

**G**

- **Generalartikel** (German). General articles: the instructions of a visitation that applied to every parish of a territory.
- **German psalm** (German *deutscher Psalm*). Any German hymn sung by the people, not only a psalm paraphrase. See §8.5.1.
- **Gnesio-Lutherans** (Greek *gnesios*, "genuine"). The strict Lutheran party, led by Flacius, that resisted the Interim and the Philippists; also called Flacians. See §17.1.1.
- **godparents** (German *Gevatter*, *Paten*). The sponsors at baptism, who answer for the child and promise to see it taught. See §13.3.8, §17.17.4.
- **Gottesacker** (German). "God's acre": the burial ground, often outside the town. See §13.9.4.
- **gradual**. (1) The chant after the epistle, taken from a psalm. (2) The choir book of the chants of the Mass. See §4.6.

**H**

- **Hagelfeier** (German). A holy day of processions against hail, forbidden by the orders. See §12.11.4.
- **Hanc igitur** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that offers "this oblation of our service". See §7.6.5, and *Canon*.
- **Handschlag** (German; Latin *stipulata manu*). The handclasp by which a promise was given, in betrothal and in the pledges of ministers and church officers. See §13.7.8.
- **Hauptlied** (German). "Chief hymn": the hymn of the day for a Sunday or feast. The word is later and does not occur in the corpus. See §8.A.
- **Hochzeit** (German). A wedding. In older use also a high feast, as in "the four *Hochzeiten*" (see *Vierzeiten*).

**I**

- **Indulgentiam** (Latin). The absolution after the *Confiteor* and *Misereatur*: "May the almighty and merciful Lord grant us pardon, absolution and remission of our sins". See §3.4.3.
- **infulae** (Latin). Properly the mitre and its bands. In the Transylvanian synods the word most likely means the chasubles. See §14.7.3.
- **inspector**. An overseer of the pastors of a district, a name used in some territories beside or for the superintendent. See §15.4.1.

- **Interim**. The Augsburg Interim of 1548, the emperor's provisional settlement of religion until a council, which allowed the Protestants only the cup and married priests; and the Leipzig Interim (1548/49), Electoral Saxony's milder version. See §1.4.
- **Introibo** (Latin). "I will go unto the altar of God" (Ps 43:4), the antiphon of the priest's preparation, said with Psalm 43, *Iudica me*. See §3.3.1.
- **introit**. The entrance chant of the Mass: an antiphon with a psalm verse and the *Gloria Patri*. Its first words name the Sunday in many cases. See §4.4.
- **investiture** (German *Investitur*). The installation of a pastor in his parish by the superintendent, a rite apart from ordination. See §13.11.
- **invitatory**. Psalm 95, *Venite*, sung with an antiphon at the beginning of Matins. See §10.5.2.
- **Ite, missa est** (Latin). "Go, it is the dismissal": the deacon's dismissal at the end of Mass on days with a Gloria. See §2.13.1.
- **Iudica me** (Latin). Psalm 43, "Judge me, O God", said by the priest at the foot of the altar. It survives in the evangelical orders as the introit of Judica Sunday. See §3.3.8.

**K**

- **Kaland** (German, plural *Kalande*). A brotherhood of clergy and lay people that met on the first day of the month, the Kalends, for Masses for the dead and a common meal. See §16.7.6.
- **Kastenherren** (German). The managers of the common chest (*gemeiner Kasten*), the fund that took over the church's endowments for the ministers, the schools and the poor. See §16.5.2.
- **Kinderlehre** (German). The catechism class for children on Sunday afternoons, held by question and answer. See §11.4.3, §10.10.
- **Kirchenordnung** (German). A church order: the law that a prince or a city council gave its church. It says who shall preach and what, how the sacraments and the services are to be held, and how ministers, schools and discipline are to be ordered. See §1.2.1.
- **Kirchenrat** (German). A church council: a board of theologians and councillors that governed the church under the prince, as in Württemberg and the Palatinate. See §15.5.
- **Kirchgang** (German). "Going to church": the churching of a mother; the bridal party's procession to church; or church attendance in general. See §13.5.2.
- **Kirchweih** (German; also *Kirmes*, *Kirchmesse*). The anniversary of a church's dedication, and the fair and festivities that went with it. See §13.14.4.
- **Kyrie chants**. The named plainsong settings of the Kyrie, each assigned to a season or a rank of feast: the *dominicale*, *paschale*, *angelicum*, *summum*, *minus summum*, *apostolicum*, *Fons bonitatis*, *Magne Deus*, *de martyribus* and *de virginibus*. The orders with Latin schools kept them by name. See §2.6.2, §12.4.2.

**L**

- **Lauds**. The morning office of praise, sung after Matins, with the canticle *Benedictus*. See Chapter 10.
- **Lavabo** (Latin). The washing of the priest's hands at the offertory, with Psalm 26:6, "I will wash my hands in innocency". See §2.1.
- **lectio continua** (Latin). Reading a book of Scripture straight through, chapter after chapter, instead of the passages appointed for each Sunday. See §4.5.2.
- **Leichpredigt** (German). The funeral sermon. See §11.4.6.
- **Leise** (German; plural *Leisen*). A medieval German hymn of the people whose stanzas end *Kyrieleis*, such as "Christ ist erstanden", sung at the high feasts. See §8.10.2.
- **Lenten veil** (German *Hungertuch*). The cloth hung before the altar or the choir through Lent. See §14.1.
- **levites** (German *Leviten*). In the south German imperial cities, the two assistants at the altar, the gospeller and the epistoler, named after the ministers of the Old Testament. Outside the cathedrals they were in practice priests. See §16.4.3.
- **litany**. A long prayer of petitions, sung by two voices or choirs answering one another. In the orders it is usually Luther's German or Latin litany of 1529, sung on weekdays, on prayer days and in time of war or plague. See §10.7.5, §13.22.
- **little hours**. Prime, Terce, Sext and None, the short offices of the first, third, sixth and ninth hours of the day. See §10.4.2.
- **Loci** (Latin). Melanchthon's *Loci communes*, first published in 1521 and much revised, the handbook of Lutheran doctrine, named in many orders as a standard of teaching. See §17.5.1.

**M**

- **maniple**. A strip of cloth worn over the left forearm by the priest at Mass. See §14.2.3.
- **marriage court** (German *Ehegericht*). The court that judged betrothal, marriage and divorce cases; in many territories the consistory. See §13.7.9.
- **Matins** (German *Mette*). The night office of psalms, lessons and responsories. In the evangelical orders it was mostly a school office early in the morning. See §10.5.2.
- **Memento** (Latin). The prayers of the Canon for the living and for the dead, "Remember, O Lord". See §7.6.4, and *Canon*.
- **minor orders**. The four lower grades of the clergy below the subdiaconate: porter, lector, exorcist and acolyte. The evangelical orders did not confer them. See §16.3.
- **Misereatur** (Latin). "May almighty God have mercy upon thee": the prayer for forgiveness that answers the *Confiteor*. See §3.4.3.
- **monstrance**. A vessel with a glass case in which the consecrated host was shown for adoration and carried in procession. See §13.18.4.
- **motet**. A polyphonic setting of a Latin or German text, sung by the choir on feasts. See §4.9.2.

**N**

- **Nobis quoque** (Latin). "To us sinners also": the prayer of the Canon after the memento of the dead, asking a share with the saints. See *Canon*.
- **norma doctrinae** (Latin). "A norm of doctrine": the confession or list of books by which a church's teaching was to be judged. See §17.14.2.
- **notel** (Low German). A written form or statement. (1) The Lower Saxon exhortation to prayer read "from the notel" after the sermon (see §6.14). (2) Danzig's confessional statement of 1562 (see §17.7.3).
- **Nunc dimittis** (Latin). The Song of Simeon, "Lord, now lettest thou thy servant depart in peace", sung at Compline and in some orders after communion. See §2.13.2.

**O**

- **octave**. The eighth day after a great feast, or the whole week to that day, kept with the feast's propers. See §12.4.4.
- **Offene Schuld** (German). "The open guilt": the general confession and absolution of the medieval preaching service, said after the sermon. Several orders moved it into the Mass. See §3.3.5.
- **offertory**. The chant and prayers at the preparation of the bread and wine. To Luther they "smelled of oblation", and most orders dropped them. See §4.7.
- **Orate fratres** (Latin). "Pray, brethren": the priest's request for the people's prayers at the offertory. See §7.6.1.
- **Ordnung** (German). An order, the general word for the documents in the set: *Kirchenordnung* (church order), *Gottesdienstordnung* (order of service), *Visitationsordnung* (visitation order), *Konsistorialordnung* (consistory order), *Kirchenzuchtordnung* (order of church discipline), *Schulordnung* (school order). See §1.2.4.

**P**

- **pall**. A stiffened square of linen laid over the chalice. See §14.6.2.
- **paraments**. The cloths and hangings of a church: the covers of the altar, the pulpit and the font. See §14.6.
- **paschale** (Latin). See *Kyrie chants*.
- **paten**. The small plate for the host at Mass. See §14.6.7.
- **Patrem** (Latin). The Nicene Creed, named from the words the choir takes up after the priest's intonation *Credo in unum Deum*: *Patrem omnipotentem*. See §2.9.
- **Pax** (Latin). The peace: the greeting *Pax Domini sit semper vobiscum*, "The peace of the Lord be always with you", before the Agnus Dei, and the kiss of peace that went with it. Luther called the greeting "a kind of public absolution". See §2.8, §2.15.9.
- **Per ipsum** (Latin). "By him, and with him, and in him": the doxology that ends the Canon. See *Canon*.
- **pericope**. A passage of Scripture appointed to be read on a given Sunday or feast: the epistle or gospel of the day. See §4.5.
- **Placeat** (Latin). The priest's prayer to the Trinity before the blessing at the end of Mass, *Placeat tibi, sancta Trinitas*. See §7.2.7.
- **plainsong**. The unaccompanied, single-line chant of the Latin liturgy. See §4.10.

- **police order** (German *Polizeiordnung*). An order of public discipline, for dress, feasting, weddings, swearing and Sunday rest. "Police" has its old sense, the good order of a community. See §1.2.4.
- **postcommunion**. The collect after communion. In the Lutheran orders it was usually Luther's thanksgiving of 1526. See §5.6.
- **postil** (German *Postille*). A book of sermons on the Sunday gospels and epistles, from which pastors preached or read, such as Luther's *Hauspostille*. See §11.8.
- **prayer bell** (German *Betglocke*). The bell rung morning, noon and evening for prayer, which the orders turned into a bell *pro pace*, for peace, for the government and against the Turk. See §9.5.3.
- **prayer day** (German *Bettag*). A day of prayer and repentance appointed by the authorities, weekly, monthly or in time of war, plague and the Turkish threat, with a sermon of repentance at its centre. See §11.4.5.
- **preces** (Latin). A series of short versicles and responses, with the Kyrie and the Lord's Prayer, said at the end of an office. See §10.7.5.
- **Preface**. The thanksgiving that opens the eucharistic prayer, after the dialogue *Sursum corda*, and leads into the Sanctus. The *Proper Prefaces* vary it for the seasons and feasts. See §2.10, §4.8.
- **presbyterae** (Latin). The women elders of the Bohemian Brethren, elected by the women. See §16.6.4.
- **private confession** (German *Beicht*, *Ohrenbeicht*). Confession of sins to the pastor alone, with his absolution, before communion. See §13.17.
- **Probepredigt** (German). The trial sermon a candidate preached before his examination or appointment. See §11.11.2.
- **public penance** (German *Kirchenbuße*). Penance done before the congregation for an open sin, ending in public reconciliation. See §13.16.
- **pyx**. A small box for the host, above all for carrying the sacrament to the sick. See §14.6.7.

**Q**

- **Quam oblationem** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon before the Words of Institution, asking that the offering be made "the Body and Blood" of Christ. See §7.6.6, and *Canon*.
- **Qui pridie** (Latin). "Who the day before he suffered": the Canon's account of the institution. See §7.6.7.
- **Quod ore sumpsimus** (Latin). "What we have taken with our mouth": a postcommunion prayer, which Luther kept in 1523. See §5.6.1.

**R**

- **recess** (German *Abschied*). The written decisions issued at the end of a visitation, a synod or a diet.
- **Repetitio** (Latin). The *Confessio Saxonica* of 1551, Melanchthon's restatement of the Augsburg Confession for the Council of Trent, part of the *Corpus doctrinae Philippicum*. Naming it marks an order as Philippist or Reformed. See §17.3.3.
- **responsory**. A chant of response and verse, with the response repeated, sung after a lesson at Matins and elsewhere.
- **Revers** (German). A signed undertaking by which a minister or church officer bound himself to his duties or his confession on taking office. See §17.4.
- **Rogation days** (German *Bittwoche*, *Kreuzwoche*). The three days before Ascension Day, with processions through the fields to pray for the harvest. See §12.12.5.

**S**

- **sacrament house** (German *Sakramentshäuslein*). A tall stone shrine in the chancel in which the consecrated host was reserved. See §14.5.5.
- **Sacramentarians**. In the Lutheran polemic, those who denied the bodily presence of Christ in the Supper: the Zwinglians and, later, the Calvinists.
- **Salve Regina** (Latin). "Hail, Queen": the antiphon to the Virgin sung in the evening after Compline. The orders abolished it or turned it to Christ. See §8.16.5.
- **Sanctus bell**. A small bell rung at the Sanctus and at the elevation. See §9.5.4.
- **Schwenckfelders**. The followers of Caspar Schwenckfeld, a Silesian spiritualist who set the inner word above the outward word and sacraments. See §1.3.6.
- **screen** (German *Lettner*, *Schranken*, *Gitter*). The partition, rail or grille that divided the choir from the nave. See §14.5.7.
- **secret** (Latin *secreta*). The prayer said quietly over the gifts at the end of the offertory, abolished with it. See §5.5.
- **Seelfrau** (German, plural *Seelfrauen*). A woman appointed by the town council to nurse the sick and to attend and comfort the dying. See §16.7.3.

- **seniores** (Latin; German *Eltesten*). Elders: laymen chosen to keep church discipline with the ministers. In the Reformed orders they governed the church with them. See §16.6.
- **Septuagesima** (Latin). The ninth Sunday before Easter, with Sexagesima and Quinquagesima (*Estomihi*) after it: the pre-Lenten season. See §13.21.7.
- **sequence**. A rhymed chant sung after the alleluia on feasts, such as *Victimae paschali* at Easter. The orders cut the sequences back to the chief feasts, or farsed them with German stanzas. See §4.6.4, §8.8.3.
- **Stipendium** (Latin). A foundation that maintained poor students of theology, as the ducal *Stipendium* at Tübingen. See §15.7.2.
- **stole**. A long narrow band of cloth worn round the neck by priests and deacons. See §14.7.3.
- **Stufengebet** (German). "The prayer at the steps": the priest's preparation at the foot of the altar, with *Introibo*, Psalm 43 and the *Confiteor*. See §3.3.1.
- **subdeacon** (Latin *subdiaconus*). The cleric of the lowest major order, who sang the epistle at a solemn Mass. The evangelical orders did not confer the order. See §16.3.
- **suffrages**. Short petitions with their responses, said at the end of an office or in the litany. See §10.7.5.
- **summa festa** (Latin). The highest feasts. See §12.4.2.
- **summum** (Latin). The highest grade of chant and feast, with *minus summum* below it. See §12.4.2, and *Kyrie chants*.
- **Sunday names**. The Sundays of Lent and Eastertide are named by the opening words of their introit: *Invocavit*, *Reminiscere*, *Oculi*, *Laetare* and *Judica* in Lent; *Quasimodogeniti*, *Misericordias Domini*, *Jubilate*, *Cantate*, *Rogate* and *Exaudi* after Easter.
- **super populum** (Latin). The *oratio super populum*, "the prayer over the people", said after the postcommunion on the weekdays of Lent, with the bidding *Humiliate capita vestra Deo*, "Bow down your heads before God". See §5.6.6.
- **superintendent** (Latin *superattendens*). The minister who oversaw the pastors of a district or a whole territory, in place of a bishop. See §15.4.
- **Supplices** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon asking that the offering be carried by the angel to the altar on high. See §7.6.9, and *Canon*.
- **Supra quae** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon that asks God to look on the offering as on those of Abel, Abraham and Melchizedek. See §7.6.8.
- **surplice** (German *Chorrock*, *Chorhemd*; Latin *superpellicium*). A wide white linen garment with sleeves. In many Lutheran orders it was the minister's vestment. See §14.7.4.
- **Sursum corda** (Latin). "Lift up your hearts": the dialogue that opens the Preface. See §2.10.

**T**

- **Taufbüchlein** (German). Luther's "little book of baptism", the German order of baptism of 1523, revised in 1526. See §13.3.2, §13.3.3.
- **Te igitur** (Latin). "Thee therefore, most merciful Father": the first prayer of the Canon, which commends the Church, the pope and the bishop. See §7.6.3, and *Canon*.
- **Tenebrae** (Latin, "darkness"). The Matins and Lauds of the last three days of Holy Week, at which the candles were put out one by one. Some orders also name a Tenebrae ringing on Fridays for the Passion. See §9.5.3.
- **thurifer**. The server who carried the censer. See §16.4.4.
- **tract**. The chant sung in place of the alleluia from Septuagesima to Easter. See §4.6.

**U**

- **Unde et memores** (Latin). The prayer of the Canon after the institution that remembers the Passion, Resurrection and Ascension and offers the sacrifice. See §7.6.8.

**V**

- **variata**, **invariata** (Latin). The altered edition of the Augsburg Confession that Melanchthon published in 1540 (*variata*), and the unaltered confession of 1530 (*invariata*). See §17.3.2.
- **Verba** (Latin). The Words of Institution of the Lord's Supper, "Our Lord Jesus Christ, the same night in which he was betrayed". See §2.11.
- **versicle**. A short verse said or sung by the minister and answered by the people or the choir. See §3.3.
- **Vierzeiten** (German; Low German *veer tide*). "The four times": in north Germany the four chief feasts, Christmas, Easter, Whitsuntide and Michaelmas (formerly the Assumption), on which the four-times penny was paid. See §12.9.

- **vigil**. The day before a great feast, or the night office kept on it. See §12.4.6.
- **visitation**. (1) The inspection of the parishes by commissioners of the prince or council, who examined pastors and people and set down their orders in a recess. (2) The feast of the Visitation of Mary, 2 July. See §1.2.4, §12.8.2.

**W**

- **weather-ringing** (German *Wetterläuten*). Ringing the bells against storms and hail, which many orders forbade as superstition. See §9.5.8, §13.15.5.
- **Westerhemd** (German). The white christening robe put on the child after baptism. See §13.3.3.